

# **Medical Dictionary by Specialty**

A Comprehensive Reference of Medical Terminology

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## Preface

This dictionary is a concise reference to medical terms, diseases, investigations, treatments, anatomy, physiology, and related clinical concepts. It is intended to help students, healthcare professionals, educators, and general readers understand unfamiliar medical language.

The entries are arranged alphabetically from A to Z, with each letter presented in its own chapter. This arrangement allows a reader to locate a known term quickly while maintaining a consistent structure throughout the book. Related terms, recognized common names, and alternative names are included when they improve clarity or aid searching.

Definitions are written in simple, formal language and are intended to be clear, accurate, and useful for reference. Medical terminology changes as scientific knowledge and clinical guidance develop; therefore, important information should be checked against current textbooks, primary research, professional guidance, and local clinical protocols.

This book is an educational reference, not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Readers should seek advice from a qualified healthcare professional when making decisions about health.

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## A

### 5-Alpha Reductase Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks conversion of testosterone to dihydrotestosterone. It is used mainly to treat benign prostatic hyperplasia and androgen-related hair loss.

### Adaptive Design

A clinical-study design that permits planned changes in response to accumulating data while preserving validity.

### ADME

Absorption, distribution, metabolism, and excretion: the processes governing a substance's movement through the body.

#### Synonyms:

Pharmacokinetics

### Administration Procedure

A procedure used to deliver a medicine, fluid, vaccine, or other intervention to a patient.

### Adnexal Dysplasia

Abnormal precancerous or developmental cellular changes in tissue beside the uterus, such as the ovary or tube.

### ADP-Ribosylation

Addition of an ADP-ribose group to a protein or other molecule, altering its activity or interactions.

### Adrenomedullin

A peptide hormone that promotes blood-vessel dilation and helps regulate circulation and fluid balance.

### Adsorption

Attachment of molecules to the surface of a solid or liquid rather than absorption into its interior.

### Aerobiosis

A state or process requiring the presence of oxygen.

### Aerosol

A suspension of fine solid particles or liquid droplets in a gas.

### Affinity Chromatography

A laboratory separation method that isolates a molecule through its specific binding to an immobilized partner.

### Agammaglobulinemia

A severe deficiency or absence of immunoglobulins, causing recurrent infections.

### Ainhum

A rare disorder causing a constricting groove around a toe that may eventually lead to autoamputation.

#### Synonyms:

Dactylolysis spontanea

### Alarmin

A molecule released by damaged or stressed cells that activates innate immune responses.

### Alcoholic Hepatitis

Inflammation and liver injury caused by heavy alcohol use.

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### **Alcoholic Intoxication**

Impaired judgment, coordination, or consciousness caused by acute alcohol exposure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Alcohol intoxication

### **Alcoholism**

A chronic disorder characterized by impaired control over alcohol use and continued use despite harm.

#### **Synonyms:**

Alcohol use disorder

### **Alexithymia**

Difficulty identifying, describing, or distinguishing one's emotional experiences.

### **Alkaptonuria**

An inherited disorder of tyrosine metabolism causing homogentisic-acid accumulation and darkening of urine or tissues.

### **Anorectal Infection**

Infection involving the anus, rectum, or surrounding tissues.

### **Aortopulmonary Window**

A congenital opening between the ascending aorta and pulmonary artery.

### **Aponeurosis**

A broad, flat sheet of connective tissue that attaches muscle to bone or other tissues.

### **Apoptotic Body**

A membrane-bound fragment of a cell undergoing programmed cell death.

### **Arterial Embolization**

Intentional blockage of an artery, often to control bleeding or reduce blood supply to a tumor.

### **Arterial Injury**

Damage to an artery that may cause bleeding, narrowing, clotting, or impaired blood flow.

### **Arterial Stenosis**

Abnormal narrowing of an artery.

### **Arterial Thrombosis**

Formation of a blood clot within an artery.

### **Arteritis**

Inflammation of an artery.

### **Artery Occlusion**

Complete or near-complete blockage of an artery.

### **Arthropod Vector**

An arthropod, such as a mosquito or tick, that transmits an infectious agent between hosts.

#### **Synonyms:**

Disease vector

### **Arthus Reaction**

A localized immune-complex reaction causing inflammation at the site of antigen exposure.

#### **Synonyms:**

AI

### **Artificial Saliva**

A product used to moisten the mouth and relieve symptoms of dry mouth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Saliva substitute

### **Assay**

A laboratory procedure used to detect or measure a substance, activity, or biological response.

### **Asthenozoospermia**

Reduced sperm motility, which may contribute to difficulty conceiving.

#### **Synonyms:**

Asthenospermia

### **Asymptomatic Infections**

Infections present without noticeable symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Subclinical infections

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### Atopic Rhinitis

Allergic inflammation of the nasal lining causing sneezing, itching, congestion, or discharge.

**Synonyms:**

Allergic rhinitis

### Atrial Ablation

A procedure that destroys selected heart tissue to prevent or control an atrial arrhythmia.

**Synonyms:**

Cardiac ablation

### Atrophoderma Maculatum

A rare skin condition causing localized, depressed patches of altered pigmentation and tissue thinning.

### Atypia Morphology

Abnormal cellular appearance or architecture that may be benign, reactive, precancerous, or cancerous depending on context.

**Synonyms:**

Cytologic atypia

### Augmentation Mammoplasty

Surgery to increase breast size or alter breast shape, commonly using implants or fat transfer.

**Synonyms:**

Breast augmentation

### Avoidance Behavior

Deliberate behavior intended to prevent contact with a feared, distressing, or threatening situation.

### Axis Vertebra

The second cervical vertebra, which supports rotation of the first cervical vertebra and head.

**Synonyms:**

C2; axis

### Axolemma

The cell membrane surrounding an axon.

### Adherens Junction

A cell-to-cell connection that uses cadherin proteins

to link neighboring cells through actin filaments.

### Adipocyte

A cell specialized to store and release fat.

**Synonyms:**

Fat cell

### Adipogenesis

The formation and maturation of fat cells.

### Adipokine

A signaling molecule released by adipose tissue that influences metabolism or inflammation.

### Adjustment Disorders

Emotional or behavioral symptoms occurring in response to an identifiable stressor and causing significant distress or impairment.

**Synonyms:**

Adjustment disorder

### Adnexal Mass

A growth or enlargement involving structures beside the uterus, such as an ovary or fallopian tube.

### Adnexitis

Inflammation of an adnexal structure, usually the fallopian tube or ovary.

**Synonyms:**

Salpingo-oophoritis

### Adoptive Immunotherapy

Treatment in which immune cells are collected, modified or activated, and returned to the patient.

### Adrenal Cancer

Cancer arising in the adrenal gland.

**Synonyms:**

Adrenocortical cancer

### Adrenal Medulla

The inner part of the adrenal gland that produces epinephrine and norepinephrine.

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### **Adrenergic Agent**

A substance that affects receptors responsive to adrenaline-like neurotransmitters.

### **Adrenergic Agonist**

A substance that activates adrenergic receptors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sympathomimetic

### **Adrenergic Antagonists**

Substances that block the effects of adrenaline-like signaling at adrenergic receptors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Adrenergic blockers

### **Adrenergic Receptor**

A cell receptor activated by epinephrine or norepinephrine.

### **Adrenoleukodystrophy**

An inherited disorder causing abnormal buildup of very-long-chain fatty acids and progressive nervous-system or adrenal damage.

#### **Synonyms:**

ALD

### **Adult Rickets**

Defective bone mineralization in adulthood, usually called osteomalacia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Osteomalacia

### **Adventitia**

The outer connective-tissue layer of a blood vessel or hollow organ.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tunica adventitia

### **Adverse Reaction**

An unintended, harmful response to a medicine, treatment, or other exposure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Adverse drug reaction

### **Aerobic Exercise**

Physical activity that uses sustained oxygen-dependent energy production, such as walking or cycling.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardio exercise

### **Afferent Pathway**

A sensory nerve route carrying information from the body toward the brain or spinal cord.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sensory pathway

### **Afibrinogenemia**

A rare inherited or acquired absence of fibrinogen, causing impaired blood clotting.

### **African Trypanosomiasis**

A parasitic infection transmitted by tsetse flies and affecting the blood and nervous system.

#### **Synonyms:**

African sleeping sickness

### **Agglutination Test**

A laboratory test in which particles visibly clump when a specific antibody or antigen is present.

### **Agglutinin**

An antibody or other substance that causes cells or particles to clump together.

### **AIDS Vaccine**

A vaccine designed to prevent HIV infection or reduce its effects; no generally effective licensed vaccine currently exists.

### **Air Sac**

A cavity or thin-walled space that contains air, such as a pulmonary alveolus or bird air sac.

#### **Synonyms:**

Air space

### **Air Trapping**

Retention of air in the lungs because it cannot be

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fully exhaled, often from airway obstruction.

### **Alanine**

An amino acid used in protein synthesis and glucose metabolism.

### **Albumin Clearance**

The removal rate of albumin from blood or another body compartment, used in selected physiologic studies.

### **Alveolar Macrophage**

An immune cell in the lung air sacs that removes particles, microbes, and cellular debris.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dust cell

### **Alzheimer's**

A progressive neurodegenerative disease causing memory loss and decline in thinking and daily function.

#### **Synonyms:**

Alzheimer disease

### **Ambulance**

A vehicle equipped to transport and provide emergency medical care to ill or injured people.

### **Amebic Colitis**

Inflammation of the colon caused by infection with *Entamoeba histolytica*.

#### **Synonyms:**

Amoebic colitis

### **Amnioscope**

An instrument used to inspect amniotic fluid and the membranes through the cervix.

### **Amyloid Protein**

A normally soluble protein that has misfolded into insoluble fibrils and may accumulate in tissues.

#### **Synonyms:**

Amyloid

### **Anaerobic**

Able to live, grow, or function without oxygen.

### **Anaerobic Bacteria**

Bacteria that grow without oxygen; some are harmed by oxygen.

### **Anal Carcinoma**

Cancer arising in the anus or anal canal.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anal cancer

### **Anal Mucositis**

Inflammation and ulceration of the anal mucous membrane, often after radiation or chemotherapy.

### **Anal Necrosis**

Death of tissue in or around the anus.

### **Anal Pain**

Pain felt in or around the anus.

#### **Synonyms:**

Proctalgia

### **Angiogenesis Inhibitor**

A treatment or substance that prevents or slows formation of new blood vessels.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antiangiogenic agent

### **Antinuclear Autoantibody**

An autoantibody directed against components of a cell nucleus.

#### **Synonyms:**

ANA

### **Antisepsis**

Use of chemical methods to reduce or eliminate harmful microorganisms on living tissue.

### **Antiserum**

Blood serum containing antibodies against a particular antigen or toxin.

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### **Antisocial Personality**

A persistent pattern of disregard for other people's rights, social rules, and responsibilities.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antisocial personality disorder

### **Antitoxin**

An antibody or preparation that neutralizes a toxin.

### **Alpha-Fetoprotein**

A protein produced mainly by the fetal liver; maternal or blood levels can help assess certain fetal and adult conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

AFP; alpha fetoprotein (alternate spelling).

### **Alpha-Globulin**

A group of blood proteins that includes transport and acute-phase proteins.

### **Alpha-Synuclein**

A neuronal protein that can accumulate abnormally in disorders such as Parkinson disease and Lewy-body dementia.

### **Alpha-Thalassemia**

An inherited disorder in which reduced alpha-globin production impairs hemoglobin formation.

### **Amniotic Band**

A strand of amniotic tissue that can entangle or constrict developing fetal body parts.

#### **Synonyms:**

Amniotic band sequence

### **Aortic Body**

A small group of chemoreceptor cells near the aortic arch that helps sense blood oxygen and carbon dioxide.

### **Aortic Injury**

Damage to the aorta, often caused by severe trauma or a medical procedure.

### **Aortic Rupture**

A life-threatening tear through the wall of the aorta causing internal bleeding.

### **Anaplastic Astrocytoma**

A high-grade astrocytic brain tumor with rapid growth and infiltrative behavior.

### **Anaplastic Ependymoma**

An aggressive, high-grade tumor arising from cells lining the brain's ventricles or spinal canal.

### **Anatomical Conduit**

A natural or surgically created passage that carries fluid, air, tissue, or another structure.

### **Anatomical Orifice**

A natural opening into or through a body structure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Body opening

### **Anatomist**

A specialist who studies the structure of the body.

### **Androgen Excess**

Abnormally high androgen activity or concentration, which can cause acne, excess hair, or menstrual changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hyperandrogenism

### **Androgen Insufficiency**

Inadequate androgen production or activity for a person's physiologic needs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Androgen deficiency

### **Androgen Receptor**

A cellular protein that binds testosterone or related hormones and mediates their effects.

### **Androgen Suppression**

Reduction of androgen production or action, used in selected hormone-sensitive conditions.



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**Synonyms:**

Androgen deprivation

**Anesthesiologist**

A physician who provides anesthesia and manages pain and vital functions during procedures.

**Anesthesiology**

The medical specialty concerned with anesthesia, perioperative care, and pain management.

**Anesthetic**

A medicine or technique that causes loss of sensation, with or without loss of consciousness.

**Angiocardiology**

Imaging of the heart and major vessels after injection of contrast material.

**Angiofibroma**

A benign tumor composed of blood vessels and fibrous tissue.

**Angioid Streak**

Breaks in a tissue layer beneath the retina that appear as irregular dark lines.

**Ankle**

The joint connecting the lower leg to the foot.

**Ankyloglossia**

An abnormally short or tight lingual frenulum that restricts tongue movement.

**Synonyms:**

Tongue-tie

**Ankyrin**

A structural protein that links membrane proteins to the cell's internal cytoskeleton.

**Anomia**

Difficulty retrieving or naming familiar words.

**Anorectal Fistula**

An abnormal channel connecting the anus or rectum with nearby skin or another organ.

**Synonyms:**

Anal fistula

**Antigen Receptor**

A receptor on an immune cell that specifically recognizes an antigen.

**Antiplatelet Agent**

A medicine that reduces platelet clumping and lowers the risk of arterial clots.

**Synonyms:**

Antiplatelet medicine

**Aortic Disease**

Any disorder affecting the aorta, including aneurysm, dissection, narrowing, or inflammation.

**Arthroscope**

A small illuminated instrument used to view the inside of a joint.

**Articular Ligament**

A band of connective tissue that stabilizes a joint by connecting bone to bone.

**Synonyms:**

Joint ligament

**Artificial Heart**

A mechanical device that replaces or supports the pumping function of the heart.

**Artificial Skin**

A biological or synthetic material used to cover wounds and support skin regeneration.

**Synonyms:**

Skin substitute

**Ascitic Fluid**

Excess fluid collected in the abdominal cavity.

**Synonyms:**

Ascites

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### **Asphyxia Neonatorum**

Failure of a newborn to establish adequate breathing at or shortly after birth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Birth asphyxia

### **Aspirate (Substance)**

Material withdrawn from a body cavity, lesion, or airway by suction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Aspirated material

### **Assisted Circulation**

Mechanical or procedural support used to maintain blood flow when the heart cannot pump adequately.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mechanical circulatory support

### **Association Cortex**

Cerebral cortex involved in integrating information and supporting memory, language, judgment, and complex behavior.

### **Astringent**

A substance that contracts tissue and reduces secretions or minor bleeding.

### **Astrocyte**

A star-shaped glial cell that supports neurons, maintains the blood-brain barrier, and regulates the nervous-system environment.

### **Asymptomatic**

Having a disease or abnormality without noticeable symptoms.

### **Ataxia Telangiectasia**

An inherited disorder causing progressive coordination problems, visible small blood vessels, and immune deficiency.

#### **Synonyms:**

A-T

### **Atrial Arrhythmia**

An abnormal heart rhythm originating in the atria.

### **Atrial Standstill**

Absence of normal electrical and mechanical activity in the atria.

### **Atrial Thrombosis**

Formation of a blood clot within an atrium of the heart.

### **Atrioventricular Bundle**

Conducting fibers that carry electrical impulses from the atrioventricular node to the ventricles.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bundle of His

### **Attenuated Vaccine**

A vaccine made with a weakened microorganism that retains the ability to stimulate immunity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Live attenuated vaccine

### **Atypical Lymphocyte**

A lymphocyte with an unusual appearance, often reflecting immune activation or infection.

### **Audiology**

The science and clinical evaluation of hearing, balance, and related disorders.

### **Auditory Area**

A region of the cerebral cortex that processes sound information.

#### **Synonyms:**

Auditory cortex

### **Auditory Fatigue**

Temporary reduction in hearing sensitivity or listening performance after prolonged or intense sound exposure.

### **Auditory Ossicle**

One of the three small middle-ear bones that trans-

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mit sound vibrations.

**Synonyms:**

Ear ossicle

**Auditory Pathway**

The neural route carrying sound information from the inner ear to the auditory cortex.

**Auditory Threshold**

The quietest sound intensity a person can detect at a specified frequency.

**Synonyms:**

Hearing threshold

**Autism**

A neurodevelopmental condition involving persistent differences in social communication and restricted or repetitive patterns of behavior.

**Synonyms:**

Autism spectrum disorder

**Autoantigen**

A normal body molecule mistakenly targeted by the immune system in an autoimmune disease.

**Autonomic Disorder**

Dysfunction of the autonomic nervous system, which regulates involuntary cardiovascular, gastrointestinal, sudomotor, urinary, sexual, and pupillary functions. It may be primary or secondary to conditions such as diabetes, neurodegenerative disease, autoimmune neuropathy, infection, or medication effects, and may cause orthostatic hypotension, abnormal heart-rate responses, sweating abnormalities, gastrointestinal dysmotility, bladder dysfunction, or sexual dysfunction. Evaluation and treatment depend on the underlying cause and the organs affected.

**Autonomic Ganglion**

A cluster of nerve-cell bodies in the autonomic nervous system that relays signals to organs.

**Autoradiography**

An imaging technique that uses radioactive labels

to show the location of substances in tissue.

**Autosome**

Any chromosome other than a sex chromosome.

**Synonyms:**

Non-sex chromosome

**Awareness**

Conscious recognition of oneself, surroundings, thoughts, or sensations.

**Synonyms:**

Consciousness

**Axon Fasciculation**

Bundling of developing axons into organized nerve tracts.

**Axon Guidance**

The developmental process directing growing axons toward their correct targets.

**Axon Hillock**

The region of a neuron where action potentials are usually initiated.

**Axonal Transport**

Movement of proteins, organelles, and other materials along an axon.

**Axoneme**

The internal microtubule-based structure of a cilium or flagellum.

**Addictive Behavior**

Repeated substance use or rewarding behavior that becomes difficult to control despite harmful consequences.

**AIDS-Associated Nephropathy**

Kidney injury associated with advanced HIV infection.

**Synonyms:**

HIV-associated nephropathy

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### **Akinetic Mutism**

A state of profound lack of movement and speech despite wakefulness and preserved basic alertness.

### **Allergic Reaction**

An immune response to an otherwise harmless substance, ranging from mild symptoms to anaphylaxis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Allergy

### **Amnioinfusion**

Infusion of sterile fluid into the amniotic sac, often to reduce umbilical-cord compression during labor.

### **Amyloid Neuropathy**

Peripheral nerve damage caused by deposition of abnormal amyloid protein.

### **Angiogenesis Inhibition**

Suppression of new blood-vessel formation, a strategy used in some cancer treatments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antiangiogenic therapy

### **Ankle Fracture**

A break in one or more bones forming the ankle joint.

### **Anterior Chamber**

The fluid-filled space between the cornea and iris of the eye.

### **Anti-Anxiety Agents**

Medicines or other treatments used to reduce clinically significant anxiety.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anxiolytics

### **Antibody Therapy**

Treatment using antibodies to block, activate, or target a specific molecule or cell.

#### **Synonyms:**

Immunotherapy

### **Anticonvulsant**

A medicine used to prevent or control seizures; some are also used for nerve pain or mood disorders.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antiseizure medicine

### **Antigen Presentation**

Display of antigen fragments on cell surfaces for recognition by T cells.

### **Antihypertensive Agent**

A medicine or treatment that lowers elevated blood pressure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Blood-pressure medicine

### **Antipsychotic Agent**

A medicine used to treat psychosis and, in some cases, bipolar disorder or severe behavioral symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antipsychotic

### **Apathy**

Reduced motivation, emotional responsiveness, or interest in activities.

### **Appetite**

The desire or drive to eat.

### **Arthropathy**

Any disease or disorder affecting a joint.

#### **Synonyms:**

Joint disease

### **Artificial Insemination**

Placement of sperm into the reproductive tract by a medical procedure to assist conception.

#### **Synonyms:**

Intrauterine insemination

### **Aseptic Meningitis**

Inflammation of the meninges without evidence of typical bacterial meningitis, often caused by viruses

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or medicines.

### **Autoimmune Thyroiditis**

Immune-mediated inflammation and damage of the thyroid gland.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hashimoto thyroiditis

### **Axial Skeleton**

The bones of the head, neck, and trunk, including the skull, spine, ribs, and sternum.

### **Axillary Lymphadenectomy**

Surgical removal of lymph nodes from the armpit.

#### **Synonyms:**

Axillary node dissection

### **Abandoned Lead**

A disconnected or no-longer-used wire from an implanted cardiac or other electrical device that remains in the body.

#### **Synonyms:**

Retained device lead

### **Abdominal Fluid**

Fluid within the abdominal cavity; excessive accumulation is called ascites.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peritoneal fluid

### **Abdominal Neoplasm**

An abnormal tissue growth arising in an abdominal organ or structure; it may be benign or malignant.

#### **Synonyms:**

Abdominal tumor

### **Abdominoperineal Resection**

Surgery removing the rectum and anus, usually with a permanent colostomy.

#### **Synonyms:**

APR

### **Ablepharon**

A congenital absence or severe underdevelopment

of an eyelid.

### **Abnormal**

Not typical of healthy structure, function, or measurement.

### **Abnormal Color**

A color change in skin, mucosa, secretions, or another tissue that differs from the expected appearance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Discoloration

### **Abnormal Fissure**

An unusual crack, groove, or cleft in a tissue or organ.

### **Abnormal Virilization**

Development of masculinizing physical features in a person whose expected sex development does not include them, often from excess androgens.

#### **Synonyms:**

Virilization

### **Abnormality**

A structural, functional, or developmental difference from the usual state.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anomaly

### **Abomasum**

The fourth and glandular compartment of the stomach in ruminant animals.

#### **Synonyms:**

True stomach

### **Abrin**

A highly toxic plant protein from rosary pea seeds that inhibits cellular protein synthesis.

### **Absence Epilepsy**

A generalized epilepsy characterized by brief episodes of impaired awareness, often with staring and subtle movements.

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**Synonyms:**

Absence seizures

**Absent Reflex**

Failure of an expected tendon or neurologic reflex to occur when stimulated.

**Acalculous Cholecystitis**

Inflammation of the gallbladder specifically without gallstones, usually acute and occurring in critically ill, injured, postoperative, fasting, or shocked patients. Bile stasis and gallbladder ischemia contribute to the disease, which may progress rapidly to gangrene or perforation. Fever, right-upper-quadrant pain, leukocytosis, or unexplained sepsis may occur; ultrasound is commonly used for evaluation.

**Acanthocyte**

An abnormally shaped red blood cell with irregular thorn-like projections.

**Synonyms:**

Spur cell

**Acantholysis**

Loss of attachment between epidermal cells, causing cells to separate.

**Acanthoma**

A benign growth composed of thickened squamous epidermal cells.

**Acatalasia**

A rare inherited deficiency of catalase, an enzyme that breaks down hydrogen peroxide.

**Synonyms:**

Catalase deficiency

**Accelerated Growth**

Growth occurring faster than expected for a person's age, tissue, or developmental stage.

**Accelerometry**

Measurement of movement or acceleration, often used to assess activity, gait, or sleep.

**Accessory Nerve**

The eleventh cranial nerve (CN XI), a primarily motor nerve whose spinal component supplies the sternocleidomastoid and trapezius muscles. It enables head rotation and shoulder elevation; injury may cause weak head rotation, impaired shoulder shrug, and shoulder droop.

**Synonyms:**

Cranial nerve XI; spinal accessory nerve

**Accidental Death**

Death resulting from an unintentional injury or event.

**Synonyms:**

Unintentional death

**Accidental Fall**

An unintentional descent to a lower level or the ground.

**Synonyms:**

Fall injury

**Acephalostomia**

A congenital anomaly involving absence of the head and mouth.

**Achondrogenesis**

A group of severe inherited disorders in which cartilage and bone development are profoundly impaired.

**Achromatopsia**

An inherited disorder causing absent or greatly reduced color vision, often with light sensitivity and poor visual acuity.

**Synonyms:**

Complete color blindness

**Acid Phosphatase**

An enzyme that works best in acidic conditions and is found in several tissues, including prostate and blood cells.

**Synonyms:**

ACP

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### Acinar Cell

A secretory cell arranged in a cluster, such as a pancreatic cell that releases digestive enzymes.

### Acne Keloid

A chronic inflammatory condition causing firm scar-like bumps around hair follicles, usually on the back of the neck.

#### Synonyms:

Acne keloidalis nuchae

### Acquired Feminization

Development of typically female secondary sexual characteristics after birth in a person not expected to develop them, often from hormonal change.

### Acquisition Duration

The time required to obtain or record a measurement, image, or physiologic signal.

### Acrodermatitis

Inflammation affecting the skin of the hands, feet, or other distal body regions.

### Acro-Osteolysis

Resorption or destruction of the ends of the fingers or toes.

### Acrosin

An enzyme in sperm that helps it penetrate the egg's surrounding layers.

### Acrosome

A cap-like structure on the head of a sperm cell containing enzymes needed for fertilization.

### Acrosome Reaction

Release of acrosomal enzymes that enables a sperm cell to penetrate the egg's outer layers.

### Actigraphy

Monitoring of movement over time to estimate sleep-wake patterns and activity.

#### Synonyms:

Actigraphic monitoring

### Actin Myofilament

A thin muscle filament made mainly of actin that interacts with myosin during contraction.

#### Synonyms:

Thin filament

### Actin-Binding Protein

A protein that regulates, anchors, or cross-links actin filaments.

### Acting Out

Expressing emotional conflict or distress through behavior rather than words.

### Acute Disease

A condition that begins suddenly and generally lasts a limited time.

#### Synonyms:

Acute illness

### Acute Onset Pain

Pain that begins suddenly, often over seconds, minutes, or hours.

#### Synonyms:

Sudden-onset pain

### A-A Gradient

The difference between alveolar and arterial oxygen partial pressure. It helps assess gas exchange; an increased value suggests ventilation-perfusion mismatch, shunt, or impaired diffusion.

### A1C

A measure of glycated hemoglobin that estimates average blood glucose over the previous two to three months. It is used to diagnose and monitor diabetes, but some anemias and hemoglobin disorders can affect the result.

### AAA Repair

Surgical or endovascular treatment of an abdominal aortic aneurysm to prevent rupture or treat a rupture.



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## Abasia

Inability to walk despite preserved strength and the ability to move the legs in other circumstances. It usually reflects a neurologic or functional gait disorder rather than paralysis.

## ABCDE Assessment

A systematic emergency assessment of airway, breathing, circulation, disability, and exposure. Life-threatening abnormalities are treated as they are identified, with repeated reassessment.

## ABCDE Rule For Melanoma

A screening mnemonic for suspicious pigmented lesions: asymmetry, border irregularity, color variation, diameter greater than about 6 mm, and evolution. It does not diagnose melanoma; suspicious lesions require clinical assessment.

## Abdomen

The body region between the diaphragm and pelvis. It contains most digestive organs, the kidneys, spleen, pancreas, and major blood vessels and is described clinically by four quadrants or nine regions.

## Abdominal Abscess

A localized collection of pus within the abdomen, usually caused by bacterial infection, inflammation, surgery, or organ perforation. It may cause fever and abdominal pain and often requires antibiotics and drainage.

## Abdominal Aorta

The portion of the aorta below the diaphragm that extends to its bifurcation into the common iliac arteries. It supplies the abdominal organs, pelvic organs, and lower limbs through its branches.

## Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm

A localized enlargement of the abdominal aorta, usually defined as an aortic diameter of at least 3 cm or more than 50 percent above normal. Enlargement can progress to rupture.

**Synonyms:**

AAA (Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm)

## Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Screening

Ultrasound examination used to detect an abdominal aortic aneurysm before symptoms occur. Screening recommendations depend on age, sex, smoking history, and clinical risk; follow-up intervals depend on aneurysm size.

## Abdominal Aortic Ultrasound

Ultrasound imaging of the abdominal aorta used to detect or monitor an abdominal aortic aneurysm.

## Abdominal Bloating

A sensation of fullness or visible enlargement of the abdomen, commonly caused by intestinal gas, constipation, food intolerance, or functional gastrointestinal disorders. Persistent or severe bloating may require evaluation for organic disease.

## Abdominal Bruit

An abnormal blowing or whooshing sound heard over the abdomen with a stethoscope, usually caused by turbulent blood flow through a narrowed or enlarged artery. It may occur with renal-artery stenosis or an abdominal aortic aneurysm. Further assessment depends on symptoms and vascular risk factors.

## Abdominal Cavity

The cavity between the diaphragm and pelvis containing the stomach, liver, gallbladder, spleen, pancreas, kidneys, and intestines.

## Abdominal Circumference

The circumference of the fetal abdomen measured at a standardized level that includes the stomach, portal sinus, and spine. It is used with other ultrasound measurements to estimate fetal size and assess growth.

## Abdominal Colic

Cramping abdominal pain caused by contractions or obstruction of a hollow organ, such as the intestine, ureter, or bile duct. Pain often comes in waves and



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may be accompanied by nausea, vomiting, sweating, or altered bowel or urinary function. Severe or persistent pain requires prompt medical assessment.

### **Abdominal Compartment Syndrome**

Condition defined by sustained intra-abdominal pressure greater than twenty millimeters of mercury associated with new organ dysfunction. Causes include massive ascites, bowel distension from obstruction or ileus, hemorrhage, and post-surgical conditions particularly after large abdominal wall hernia repairs.

### **Abdominal CT**

Computed tomography of the abdomen used to evaluate selected causes of abdominal pain, trauma, bowel obstruction, inflammation, bleeding, and masses. The protocol and use of contrast depend on the suspected condition and the patient's clinical status.

### **Abdominal Distention**

Visible or subjective enlargement, tightness, or fullness of the abdomen caused by gas, fluid, stool, pregnancy, organ enlargement, mass, or bowel obstruction. Acute distention with pain, vomiting, obstipation, fever, haemodynamic instability, or peritoneal signs requires urgent evaluation.

### **Abdominal Girth**

The circumference of the abdomen measured at a standardized level. It is used to monitor abdominal distention, fetal growth, obesity, ascites, and changes in intra-abdominal volume.

### **Abdominal Mass**

A palpable or imaging-detected abnormal collection, enlargement, or lesion within the abdomen. Causes include distended bowel or bladder, organ enlargement, hernia, inflammatory collection, benign tumour, and malignancy; assessment depends on location, mobility, tenderness, systemic features, and appropriate imaging.

### **Abdominal Pain**

Discomfort within the abdomen classified as visceral

(dull, midline, poorly localized), parietal (sharp, well localized, worsened by movement), or referred from a distant source.

### **Abdominal Pregnancy**

An ectopic pregnancy implanted in the peritoneal cavity rather than the uterus, fallopian tubes, or ovaries. It is rare and can cause severe internal bleeding. Diagnosis requires specialist imaging and management.

### **Abdominal Radiography**

Plain projectional X-ray imaging of the abdomen, sometimes obtained in supine, erect, or decubitus positions.

### **Abdominal Reflex**

Contraction of the abdominal muscles after stimulation of the abdominal skin. An absent or asymmetric reflex may indicate neurologic disease, although it can be absent normally in some people.

### **Abdominal Rigidity**

Involuntary tensing of the abdominal wall, usually caused by irritation of the peritoneum. It may occur with peritonitis, perforation, severe infection, or intra-abdominal bleeding and requires clinical assessment.

### **Abdominal Swelling**

Visible or felt enlargement of the abdomen caused by gas, constipation, pregnancy, fluid accumulation, organ enlargement, mass, or abdominal-wall changes. Persistent, progressive, painful, or sudden swelling—especially with vomiting, fever, bleeding, or inability to pass stool or gas—requires medical evaluation.

### **Abdominal Wall**

The layered muscular, fascial, and skin-covered boundary surrounding the abdominal cavity. It supports and protects abdominal organs and helps with posture, breathing, coughing, and straining. Weakness or defects may produce abdominal or incisional hernias; trauma, infection, and tumors may also affect the wall.

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## Abdominal Wall Hernia

Protrusion of abdominal tissue through a weak area or opening in the abdominal wall. Common types include inguinal, umbilical, femoral, and incisional hernias. A painful, firm, or non-reducible bulge with vomiting or abdominal distension may indicate incarceration or strangulation and requires urgent assessment.

## Abdominal X-Ray

A plain radiograph of the abdomen used to assess selected causes of pain, obstruction, perforation, foreign bodies, or urinary stones. It has limited sensitivity for many abdominal disorders.

## Abducens Nerve

The sixth cranial nerve, a motor nerve that supplies the lateral rectus muscle and abducts the eye. Lesion of the nerve causes failure of lateral gaze and horizontal diplopia.

## Abduction

Movement of a limb or other body part away from the median plane of the body.

## Abetalipoproteinemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot produce normal apolipoprotein-B-containing lipoproteins. It causes fat malabsorption, deficiencies of fat-soluble vitamins, abnormal red cells, and possible neurologic or retinal disease.

## Abfraction

Loss of tooth structure near the gum line, possibly related to mechanical stress. It may cause tooth sensitivity and may require dental treatment.

## ABI

The ankle-brachial index, calculated by dividing ankle systolic blood pressure by arm systolic blood pressure. A low value suggests peripheral arterial disease.

## Abnormal Uterine Bleeding

Uterine bleeding that is abnormal in frequency, reg-

ularity, duration, or volume, occurring outside of normal menstruation or in women who are not pregnant.

## ABO Blood Group

A blood classification based on whether red blood cells carry A antigen, B antigen, both, or neither. The four groups are A, B, AB, and O.

## ABO Blood Typing

A laboratory test that determines a person's ABO and Rh blood groups. It is performed before transfusion, transplantation, and some obstetric procedures.

## ABO Incompatibility

An immune reaction caused by transfusion or pregnancy involving incompatible A, B, or O blood-group antigens. It can cause acute hemolysis, transfusion reactions, or hemolytic disease of the newborn. See also Hemolytic Disease of the Newborn.

## Abortion

The deliberate termination of a pregnancy by medication or a procedure. The method and clinical definition of viability vary by jurisdiction and circumstance.

## Abrasion

Superficial loss of tissue caused by friction or scraping. In dentistry, it commonly refers to mechanical loss of tooth structure from external forces.

## Abruptio Placentae

Premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall before delivery. It can cause vaginal bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fetal distress, and maternal shock and requires urgent obstetric assessment.

## Abscess

A localized collection of pus within a tissue, organ, or cavity, typically caused by bacterial infection. Abscesses form when bacteria (most commonly *Staphylococcus aureus* including MRSA) invade tis-

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sue, triggering an intense inflammatory response with neutrophil accumulation and tissue necrosis.

### **Abscessed Tooth**

A collection of pus caused by bacterial infection of the tooth or surrounding tissues, usually arising from untreated dental decay, a cracked tooth, or periodontal disease. Pain, facial swelling, fever, and sensitivity may occur. Dental treatment and drainage are usually required; swelling that affects swallowing or breathing is an emergency.

### **Absence Seizure**

A brief generalized seizure causing sudden impaired awareness and behavioral arrest, usually followed by rapid recovery. Electroencephalography commonly shows generalized three-hertz spike-and-wave activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Petit Mal Seizure Seizure, Absence Seizure, Petit Mal

### **Absent Breath Sounds**

Lack of audible air movement over part or all of a lung. Causes include pneumothorax, pleural effusion, or airway obstruction; sudden onset requires urgent assessment.

### **Absolute Neutrophil Count**

The number of circulating neutrophils calculated from the white-cell count and differential. A low ANC indicates neutropenia; severe neutropenia greatly increases the risk of serious infection.

### **Absorption**

The process by which a drug enters the bloodstream from its site of administration, such as the digestive tract, skin, or muscle.

### **Abusive Head Trauma**

Injury to an infant or young child caused by inflicted blunt impact, violent shaking, or both. Findings may include subdural hemorrhage, retinal hemorrhage, encephalopathy, fractures, or other injuries; diagnosis requires careful multidisciplinary assessment because no single finding is diagnostic.

#### **Synonyms:**

Shaken Baby Syndrome (Abusive Head Trauma)

### **Acalculia**

An acquired inability to perform previously learned numerical operations or understand numerical relationships, commonly associated with dominant parietal or other cortical dysfunction.

### **Acanthamoeba Keratitis**

A rare but potentially sight-threatening infection of the cornea caused by the free-living amoeba *Acanthamoeba*. It is strongly associated with contaminated contact-lens water or poor lens hygiene and may cause severe eye pain, redness, photophobia, blurred vision, and a ring-shaped corneal infiltrate. Prompt ophthalmic assessment and prolonged anti-amoebic treatment are required.

### **Acanthocytes (Spur Cells)**

Abnormal red blood cells with irregular, spiky, thorn-like membrane projections of varying length and width. Caused by alterations in membrane lipid composition (increased cholesterol-to-phospholipid ratio).

#### **Synonyms:**

Spur Cells

### **Acanthosis Nigricans**

Hyperpigmented, velvety, thickened plaques typically in skin flexures (neck, axillae, groin) and often associated with insulin resistance, obesity, type 2 diabetes mellitus, and metabolic syndrome.

### **Acapnia**

An abnormally low partial pressure of carbon dioxide in arterial blood, usually caused by excessive alveolar ventilation. It may accompany respiratory alkalosis, light-headedness, or paresthesias.

### **Acardia**

Absence or severe malformation of the fetal heart, usually occurring in the setting of a rare twin perfusion sequence. The affected fetus cannot sustain independent circulation.

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### Acariasis

Infestation or disease caused by mites or ticks. Clinical manifestations vary with the organism and may include dermatitis, pruritus, tissue invasion, or transmission of an associated pathogen.

### Access Needle (Interventional)

A needle used to enter a vessel, cavity, or tissue under clinical or image guidance for sampling, drainage, infusion, or placement of another device.

#### Synonyms:

Interventional

### ACE Inhibitor

A drug that inhibits angiotensin-converting enzyme, reducing formation of angiotensin II and degradation of bradykinin.

### Acetabular Labrum

A fibrocartilaginous rim attached to the margin of the acetabulum that deepens the hip socket, helps maintain a fluid seal, and contributes to hip-joint stability.

### Acetabular Notch

The indentation in the inferior margin of the acetabulum, bridged by the transverse ligament of the acetabulum and forming a passage for structures entering the hip joint.

### Acetabuloplasty

A surgical procedure that reshapes or augments the acetabular rim or socket to improve coverage of the femoral head in selected structural hip disorders.

### Acetabulum

The cup-shaped socket of the hip formed by the fused ilium, ischium, and pubis. It articulates with the femoral head and is deepened by the acetabular labrum.

### Acetaminophen (Paracetamol) Toxicity

Liver injury caused by an excessive dose of acetaminophen. Its toxic metabolite depletes glutathione and causes hepatic necrosis. N-

acetylcysteine is the antidote and should be given promptly when toxicity is suspected.

#### Synonyms:

Paracetamol

### Acetyl-CoA Carboxylase

An enzyme that converts acetyl-CoA to malonyl-CoA, the first committed step in fatty-acid synthesis. Its activity is regulated by cellular energy status and hormones.

### Acetyl-Coenzyme A

A central metabolic intermediate consisting of an acetyl group linked to coenzyme A by a high-energy thioester bond. It enters the citric acid cycle and provides carbon for fatty-acid, cholesterol, and ketone-body synthesis.

### Acetylcholine

A major neurotransmitter in both the central and peripheral nervous systems. In the peripheral nervous system, it is released at the neuromuscular junction (nicotinic receptors) to excite skeletal muscle, at all autonomic ganglia (nicotinic receptors), and at parasympathetic postganglionic terminals (muscarinic receptors).

### Achalasia

A disorder in which the lower esophageal sphincter fails to relax normally and esophageal peristalsis is impaired, causing difficulty swallowing and regurgitation.

#### Synonyms:

Cardiospasm (Achalasia)

### Achenbach's Syndrome

A benign condition of recurrent, painful, spontaneous hematoma formation in the pulp of a finger or thumb, typically affecting middle-aged women. It presents with sudden onset of throbbing pain and blue-black discoloration of the fingertip, resolving spontaneously over one to two weeks without treatment.

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## Achilles Tendinopathy

Pain and structural disorder of the Achilles tendon, usually caused by repeated loading. It causes posterior heel pain and stiffness and is managed with activity modification, rehabilitation, and treatment of contributing factors.

## Achilles Tendon (Calcaneal Tendon)

The thickest and strongest tendon in the human body, connecting the gastrocnemius and soleus (triceps surae) muscles to the calcaneus (heel bone). It plays a crucial role in plantarflexion of the foot, enabling walking, running, and jumping.

### Synonyms:

Calcaneal Tendon

## Achilles Tendon Rupture

A partial or complete tear of the Achilles tendon, usually caused by sudden force. It causes posterior ankle pain, weakness in plantar flexion, and difficulty walking or standing on tiptoe.

## Achilles Tendonitis

A commonly used term for pain and inflammation or degeneration of the Achilles tendon. It may affect the tendon at its heel insertion or its mid-portion and is often related to repetitive loading.

## Achlorhydria

Absence of hydrochloric acid in gastric secretions. It may result from autoimmune gastritis, long-term acid suppression, or loss of acid-producing stomach cells.

## Achondroplasia

Autosomal dominant skeletal dysplasia (FGFR3 gene). Most common form of dwarfism. Features: short limbs, macrocephaly, frontal bossing, trident hand, spinal stenosis. Homozygous form lethal. Normal intelligence.

### Synonyms:

Dwarfism (Achondroplasia)

## Acid

A substance that donates hydrogen ions or ac-

cepts an electron pair. In water, an acid increases hydrogen-ion concentration and lowers pH.

## Acid Base Balance

The physiological regulation of hydrogen ion concentration in body fluids, maintaining arterial pH between 7.35 and 7.45.

## Acid Reflux

Backward flow of stomach contents into the esophagus, which may cause heartburn, regurgitation, or irritation.

## Acid-Base Analysis

Evaluation of blood pH, bicarbonate, and carbon dioxide to identify metabolic or respiratory disturbances, including those caused by poisoning.

## Acid-Base Disorder

Disturbance of the body's acid-base balance, classified by primary disturbance and compensation. Respiratory acidosis: hypoventilation, high PaCO<sub>2</sub>, low pH. Respiratory alkalosis: hyperventilation, low PaCO<sub>2</sub>, high pH.

## Acid-Fast Bacillus Smear

Microscopic examination of a specimen, often sputum, for acid-fast organisms using a special stain. A positive result supports mycobacterial infection but does not by itself identify the species or establish drug susceptibility; culture or molecular testing is also required.

## Acidosis

An acid-base disturbance in which the concentration of hydrogen ions increases, tending to lower arterial blood pH below 7.35.

## Acinetobacter Baumannii Resistance

*Acinetobacter baumannii* is a gram-negative coccobacillus that has emerged as a significant cause of healthcare-associated infections, particularly in intensive care units. The organism has intrinsic and acquired resistance mechanisms, including beta-lactamases, efflux pumps, and porin mutations.

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## ACL Injuries

Sprains or tears of the anterior cruciate ligament of the knee, usually caused by twisting, sudden deceleration, or contact trauma. They may cause instability, swelling, and difficulty pivoting; examination and imaging guide management.

## ACL Reconstruction

Surgical reconstruction of the anterior cruciate ligament (ACL) following rupture, one of the most common knee ligament injuries. The ACL is a primary restraint to anterior tibial translation and rotatory instability, and its rupture frequently occurs during non-contact pivoting sports activities (skiing, soccer, basketball).

## Acne

A chronic inflammatory disorder of hair follicles and sebaceous glands. It causes comedones, papules, pustules, or nodules, most often on the face, chest, and back.

### Synonyms:

Pimples Pimples (Acne)

## Acne Rosacea Subtypes

Rosacea may present predominantly with facial flushing and persistent redness, papules and pustules, skin thickening, or eye involvement. A person may have more than one pattern.

## Acne Vulgaris

The common form of acne caused by follicular plugging, increased sebum production, microbial activity, and inflammation. It usually affects the face, trunk, and upper arms.

## Acoustic Nerve

The acoustic nerve, more properly called the auditory or vestibulocochlear nerve (cranial nerve VIII), carries hearing and balance information from the inner ear to the brainstem.

## Acoustic Neuroma

A benign, slow-growing tumor of the vestibular portion of the vestibulocochlear nerve. It may cause

hearing loss, tinnitus, or balance problems.

## Acoustic Neuroma (Vestibular Schwannoma)

A usually benign, slow-growing tumor of Schwann cells involving the vestibular portion of cranial nerve VIII. It may cause unilateral sensorineural hearing loss, tinnitus, imbalance, or facial sensory symptoms; MRI of the internal auditory canals is the preferred diagnostic study.

### Synonyms:

Vestibular Schwannoma Neuroma, Acoustic

## Acoustic Trauma

Acute damage to the auditory system from a brief, intense sound such as an explosion or firearm. It may cause tinnitus, temporary or permanent sensorineural hearing loss, and tympanic or ossicular injury; urgent audiologic assessment is indicated when hearing loss is sudden.

## Acoustic Reflex

An involuntary contraction of the stapedius muscle in response to a loud sound. It can be measured with immittance testing and helps assess the middle-ear muscles, auditory pathways, and facial nerve.

### Synonyms:

Stapedial reflex; stapedius reflex; middle-ear muscle reflex.

## Acquisition Time

The time during which a medical imaging system collects data. The required time depends on the imaging method, body region, protocol, and patient movement.

## Acral Lentiginous Melanoma

A subtype of melanoma arising on acral skin (palms, soles, or under nails), appearing as a dark, irregularly pigmented patch or plaque. It is more common in people with darker skin tones and often presents at a later stage due to less frequent surveillance of these sites. Prognosis depends on thickness and stage at diagnosis.



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## Acrodermatitis Enteropathica

A zinc-deficiency disorder causing periorificial and acral dermatitis, alopecia, diarrhoea, poor wound healing, and increased susceptibility to infection. It may be inherited from impaired intestinal zinc absorption or acquired through malnutrition, malabsorption, or prolonged parenteral nutrition.

## Acromegaly

Chronic growth hormone (GH) excess in adulthood, typically from a pituitary somatotroph adenoma.

## Acromegaly Complications

Long-term growth-hormone excess may cause diabetes, hypertension, heart disease, sleep apnea, joint disease, nerve compression, visual problems, and other organ complications.

## Acromioclavicular Joint

A plane synovial joint between the acromion of the scapula and the lateral end of the clavicle. It permits gliding movements and is stabilized primarily by the acromioclavicular and coracoclavicular ligaments.

## Acromioclavicular Joint Injuries

Sprains or dislocations of the joint between the acromion and clavicle, usually caused by a fall or direct shoulder impact. Severity ranges from ligament sprain to complete displacement and is assessed clinically and with imaging.

## Acromion

Bony process forming the shoulder's highest point, extending laterally from the scapular spine. Articulates with the clavicle at the acromioclavicular joint and arches over the glenohumeral joint. Attachment for deltoid and trapezius. The subacromial space contains the supraspinatus tendon and subacromial bursa.

## ACTH Stimulation Test

A dynamic test of adrenal cortisol reserve using synthetic adrenocorticotrophic hormone, usually cosyntropin. An inadequate cortisol rise supports adrenal insufficiency, although interpretation depends on timing, assay, recent glucocorticoid exposure, and

whether disease is acute or chronic.

## Actinic Granuloma

A benign granulomatous skin condition arising on sun-damaged skin, presenting as annular or ring-shaped plaques with central atrophy and an elevated, erythematous border. It is thought to represent a foreign-body reaction to degenerated elastic tissue from chronic ultraviolet exposure.

## Actinic Keratosis

A rough, scaly skin lesion caused by chronic ultraviolet exposure, usually on sun-exposed skin. It can progress to squamous-cell carcinoma, so persistent, thickened, or changing lesions require clinical assessment.

### Synonyms:

Keratosis, Actinic Solar Keratosis Solar Keratosis (Actinic Keratosis)

## Actinic Keratosis Management

Actinic keratosis management requires field-directed and lesion-directed therapy. Lesion-directed: cryotherapy (liquid nitrogen, 5 to 10 second freeze-thaw cycle), curettage, electrodesiccation.

## Actinic Purpura

Bruising caused by fragile, sun-damaged skin and connective tissue, usually on the backs of the hands and forearms in older adults. The purple patches may appear after minor trauma and are generally harmless, although medicines such as anticoagulants can worsen them. New, widespread, or unexplained bruising warrants assessment.

## Actinomycetoma

A chronic, progressive granulomatous infection of the skin and subcutaneous tissue caused by aerobic actinomycetes, characterized by swelling, draining sinuses, and dark granules in the discharge. It primarily affects the feet and is endemic in tropical regions. Diagnosis is by culture and histopathology.

## Actinomycosis

A chronic infection caused by branching, gram-positive anaerobic bacteria of the genus *Actino-*

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myces, which normally colonize the mouth, gastrointestinal tract, and genital tract. It can form infiltrative masses and draining sinuses containing sulfur granules.

### **Action Potential**

A rapid, all-or-nothing depolarization of the cell membrane that propagates along excitable membranes (neurons, muscle, some endocrine cells).

### **Activated Charcoal**

A porous form of carbon that adsorbs some substances in the gastrointestinal tract and can reduce their absorption after selected poisonings. It is not effective for every toxin and can cause aspiration or other complications.

### **Activated Partial Thromboplastin Time**

A blood test that measures clotting through the intrinsic and common coagulation pathways. It may be prolonged by unfractionated heparin, clotting-factor deficiencies, inhibitors, or some liver and systemic disorders.

### **Active Caries**

Tooth decay that is continuing to progress. The affected surface is often soft, rough, or chalky and requires dental assessment and management.

### **Active Management Of Third Stage**

A set of measures used after birth to reduce postpartum hemorrhage, usually including a uterotonic medicine, controlled cord traction when appropriate, and assessment of uterine tone and bleeding.

### **Active Phase Of Labor**

The part of the first stage of labor in which the cervix dilates progressively, generally beginning at about 6 cm and continuing to full dilation. Progress varies between individuals.

### **Active Site**

The specific three-dimensional region of an enzyme where substrate binding and catalysis occur. Formed by amino acid residues that may be dis-

tant in primary sequence but brought together by protein folding.

### **Active Surveillance**

Close, structured monitoring of a cancer or precancerous condition without immediate treatment. It includes scheduled examinations, laboratory tests, imaging, or biopsies, with treatment started if evidence of progression develops.

### **Active Transport**

Movement of substances across cell membranes against their concentration gradient, requiring energy input, typically from ATP hydrolysis.

### **Activities Of Daily Living**

Routine tasks required for personal care and independent living, including basic activities and more complex instrumental activities. Performance is assessed to describe functional status and support care planning.

### **Acute**

Beginning suddenly or developing over a short period. The term may describe symptoms, illnesses, or complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bronchitis (Acute)

### **Acute Agitation**

A state of heightened motor activity, emotional tension, irritability, and impaired behavioral control that may threaten the patient or others. Management begins with de-escalation and assessment for delirium, intoxication, withdrawal, medical illness, and psychosis.

### **Acute Alcohol Intoxication**

Neurobehavioral and physiologic impairment caused by recent ethanol exposure. Severity varies with concentration, tolerance, co-ingestants, and comorbidity; dangerous effects include respiratory depression, aspiration, hypoglycemia, hypothermia, trauma, and coma.



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### **Acute Angle-Closure Glaucoma**

An ophthalmic emergency in which sudden closure of the anterior-chamber angle causes a rapid rise in intraocular pressure. Severe eye pain, blurred vision, halos, headache, nausea, vomiting, and a red eye may occur; urgent ophthalmic treatment is required to protect vision.

### **Acute Aortic Syndrome**

A spectrum of life-threatening conditions involving the thoracic aorta, including aortic dissection, intramural hematoma (IMH), and penetrating aortic ulcer (PAU). See acute aortic syndromes.

### **Acute Bacterial Rhinosinusitis**

Bacterial infection of the paranasal sinuses suspected when symptoms persist without improvement for at least 10 days, become substantially worse after initial improvement, or are severe with high fever and purulent discharge. Treatment decisions depend on severity, complications, resistance risk, and local guidance.

### **Acute Blood Loss**

Rapid loss of circulating blood volume that can cause hypovolemic shock, tissue hypoxia, tachycardia, hypotension, and acute anemia.

### **Acute Bronchitis**

Acute inflammation of the tracheobronchial tree, usually caused by a viral respiratory infection and characterized by cough, with or without sputum production, lasting up to several weeks.

### **Acute Caries**

Tooth decay that progresses rapidly, often producing a soft lesion or cavity. Risk is increased by factors such as frequent sugar exposure, reduced saliva, or poor oral hygiene.

### **Acute Cholecystitis**

Acute inflammation of the gallbladder, most often caused by persistent cystic-duct obstruction by a gallstone. It commonly causes sustained right-upper-quadrant pain, fever, nausea, and a positive Murphy sign; ultrasound and timely antimicrobial

and surgical assessment are standard.

### **Acute Acalculous Cholecystitis**

Acute gallbladder inflammation without gallstones, usually occurring in critically ill, injured, postoperative, or fasting patients. Ischaemia, bile stasis, and infection may contribute; it can progress rapidly to necrosis or perforation and requires urgent assessment.

### **Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis (ANUG)**

A painful, rapidly developing infection of the gums characterized by punched-out gingival papillae, ulceration, spontaneous bleeding, gray necrotic tissue, and foul breath. It is associated with anaerobic oral bacteria and risk factors such as poor oral hygiene, smoking, stress, malnutrition, or immunosuppression; urgent dental evaluation, cleaning, and treatment are needed.

### **Acute Coronary Syndrome**

A clinical spectrum caused by acute myocardial ischemia from plaque disruption, thrombosis, or less commonly coronary spasm. It includes unstable angina, NSTEMI, and STEMI and requires rapid assessment with symptoms, serial ECGs, and cardiac troponin testing.

### **Acute Cough**

A cough lasting less than three weeks. Common causes include viral respiratory infection, acute bronchitis, and pneumonia.

### **Acute Dacryocystitis**

Acute infection and inflammation of the lacrimal sac, most commonly caused by obstruction of the nasolacrimal duct leading to stasis and secondary bacterial infection. It presents with painful swelling, redness, and tenderness at the medial canthus with purulent discharge.

### **Acute Diarrhea**

Passage of loose or watery stools, usually three or more times daily, lasting less than two weeks. Infection, food-related illness, medicines, and other

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intestinal disorders can cause it. Oral rehydration is important; blood in stool, severe dehydration, persistent vomiting, or severe pain requires prompt assessment.

### **Acute Disseminated Encephalomyelitis**

An acute, immune-mediated demyelinating disorder, usually occurring days to weeks after an infection and less often after vaccination. It commonly causes encephalopathy with multifocal neurologic deficits, ataxia, or seizures, particularly in children.

### **Acute Esophageal Necrosis**

Ischemic necrosis of the esophageal mucosa, most commonly caused by low-flow states such as shock, sepsis, or thromboembolism, presenting with hematemesis and chest pain. Endoscopy shows circumferential black necrotic mucosa, typically in the distal esophagus.

### **Acute Exacerbation Of Asthma**

A progressive increase in dyspnea, cough, wheezing, or chest tightness with reduced expiratory airflow compared with the patient's baseline. Severe attacks may cause exhaustion, silent chest, hypercapnia, respiratory failure, and need for urgent treatment.

### **Acute Fatty Liver Of Pregnancy**

A rare, potentially life-threatening complication of late pregnancy involving liver dysfunction and microvesicular fat accumulation. It may cause nausea, abdominal pain, jaundice, low glucose, coagulopathy, or organ failure.

### **Acute Flaccid Myelitis**

A rare but serious inflammatory disorder of the spinal cord, usually affecting the gray matter and causing sudden flaccid limb weakness, reduced reflexes, and sometimes cranial-nerve or respiratory involvement. MRI and cerebrospinal-fluid studies support the diagnosis; urgent neurologic and respiratory monitoring is required.

### **Acute Generalized Exanthematous Pustulosis**

An acute drug reaction characterised by dozens to

thousands of small, sterile, nonfollicular pustules arising on an erythematous base, often with fever and neutrophilia. It usually begins rapidly after exposure to an antibiotic or other medication and resolves after withdrawal of the trigger.

### **Acute Glomerulonephritis**

Acute inflammation of the renal glomeruli causing hematuria, proteinuria, reduced glomerular filtration, edema, and often hypertension.

### **Acute Hepatitis**

Acute inflammation and injury of hepatocytes, usually developing over days to months and characterized by elevated aminotransferases, with or without jaundice, nausea, right-upper-quadrant discomfort, or constitutional symptoms.

### **Acute HIV Syndrome**

The acute retroviral syndrome occurring 2-6 weeks after primary HIV infection, corresponding to high-level viremia and immune activation. Presents with fever (most common), lymphadenopathy, pharyngitis, rash (maculopapular, trunk/face), myalgia, arthralgia, headache, nausea, diarrhea, and oral ulcers.

### **Acute Hypercapnic Respiratory Failure**

Inability to eliminate carbon dioxide, producing elevated arterial PaCO<sub>2</sub> and often respiratory acidemia. Causes include COPD exacerbation, severe asthma, neuromuscular weakness, central respiratory depression, and chest-wall restriction.

### **Acute Hypoxemic Respiratory Failure**

Inability of the respiratory system to maintain adequate arterial oxygenation, usually manifested by low arterial oxygen or oxygen saturation despite appropriate inspired oxygen. Causes include pneumonia, pulmonary edema, ARDS, atelectasis, and pulmonary embolism.

### **Acute Inflammation**

A rapid, predominantly non-specific immune response to tissue injury or infection that typically lasts hours to days and involves vascular and cellu-

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lar reactions. The cardinal signs are redness, heat, swelling, pain, and loss of function, resulting from increased blood flow, vascular permeability, and cellular infiltration.

### **Acute Interstitial Nephritis**

Inflammatory infiltrate in the renal interstitium and tubules most commonly caused by drug reactions including NSAIDs, antibiotics particularly penicillins and cephalosporins, proton pump inhibitors, and diuretics. Also caused by infections and autoimmune diseases.

### **Acute Ischemic Stroke**

Sudden neurologic dysfunction caused by focal cerebral, spinal, or retinal ischemia. Emergency evaluation distinguishes hemorrhage from ischemia and determines eligibility for reperfusion therapy while supporting airway, glucose, temperature, and blood pressure management.

### **Acute Kidney Injury**

A sudden decline in kidney function over hours or days, causing reduced filtration and possible fluid, electrolyte, or acid-base disturbances. Causes include reduced blood flow, direct kidney injury, and urinary obstruction.

#### **Synonyms:**

AKI

### **Acute Kidney Injury Staging**

A standardized classification based on changes in serum creatinine and urine output. KDIGO stages 1 through 3 quantify the severity of abrupt kidney-function decline and support prognosis, monitoring, and treatment decisions.

### **Acute Leukemia**

A leukemia characterized by a rapid onset, clonal proliferation of immature blast cells (>20% of bone marrow cells), and rapid progression without treatment. Subtypes: acute lymphoblastic leukemia (ALL, B-cell or T-cell, most common childhood cancer, peak age 2-5) and acute myeloid leukemia (AML, more common in adults, median age 65-70).

### **Acute Limb Ischemia**

Sudden reduction in arterial blood flow to a limb that threatens tissue viability, usually caused by embolism, thrombosis, or graft occlusion. The six classic findings are pain, pallor, pulselessness, paresthesia, paralysis, and poikilothermia; urgent vascular assessment and revascularization are required.

### **Acute Limb Ischemia Six Ps**

The classic findings of acute arterial perfusion loss: pain, pallor, pulselessness, paresthesia, paralysis, and poikilothermia. Motor or sensory deficit indicates threatened limb and requires urgent vascular assessment and revascularization planning.

### **Acute Liver Failure**

Rapid deterioration of liver function in a previously healthy individual without prior liver disease. Causes include acetaminophen toxicity, viral hepatitis, drug reactions, autoimmune hepatitis, and Wilson disease. Features include coagulopathy, encephalopathy, and multiorgan failure. Presents with jaundice, confusion, and bleeding.

#### **Synonyms:**

Liver Failure, Acute

### **Acute Lymphangitis**

Acute inflammation of lymphatic vessels, typically resulting from streptococcal or staphylococcal infection spreading from a distal wound. It presents with red, tender streaks extending proximally from the site of infection, along with fever, malaise, and regional lymphadenopathy. Treatment requires systemic antibiotics.

### **Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia**

A clonal malignancy of lymphoid progenitor cells, most common in children (peak age 2-5 years) but also occurring in adults with a worse prognosis with increasing age.

### **Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia**

A malignant proliferation of immature lymphoid precursors in the bone marrow and blood, commonly presenting with cytopenias, fever, bone pain, or lymphadenopathy.

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**Synonyms:**

Leukemia, Acute Lymphocytic

**Acute Megakaryoblastic Leukemia**

A rare subtype of acute myeloid leukemia characterized by the proliferation of megakaryoblasts in the bone marrow and peripheral blood.

**Acute Mesenteric Ischemia**

Occlusion or reduced flow in the mesenteric arteries causing bowel ischemia, most commonly from embolism or atherosclerosis. Presents with severe abdominal pain disproportionate to physical findings. Delayed treatment leads to bowel necrosis, perforation, and high mortality.

**Acute Mountain Sickness**

A mild altitude illness caused by rapid ascent, usually producing headache with nausea, fatigue, dizziness, or sleep disturbance. Prevention and treatment include gradual acclimatization, descent when symptoms worsen, oxygen, and appropriate medical therapy.

**Acute Myeloid Leukemia**

A clonal hematologic malignancy characterized by proliferation of immature myeloid blasts that suppress normal hematopoiesis. Diagnosis requires the appropriate blast burden or defining genetic abnormality, and presentation commonly includes anemia, infection, and bleeding from marrow failure.

**Acute Obstructive Uropathy**

Sudden impairment of urinary flow caused by obstruction of the urinary tract, potentially producing hydronephrosis, pain, infection, and acute kidney injury.

**Acute Otitis Media**

Infection of the middle ear space with acute onset of symptoms and signs of middle ear inflammation. Diagnosis requires middle ear effusion plus acute symptoms (ear pain, fever, irritability) or signs (bulging tympanic membrane, erythema). Most common pathogen: *Streptococcus pneumoniae*.

**Acute Pancreatitis**

Sudden inflammation of the pancreas, most often caused by gallstones or alcohol. It causes upper-abdominal pain and may cause vomiting or systemic complications; severity ranges from mild to life-threatening.

**Acute Promyelocytic Leukemia**

A distinct subtype of acute myeloid leukemia (AML) characterized by the t(15;17)(q24;q21) translocation, which fuses the promyelocytic leukemia (PML) gene on chromosome 15 with the retinoic acid receptor alpha (RARA) gene on chromosome 17.

**Acute Rehabilitation**

Multidisciplinary rehabilitation provided during or soon after hospitalization for conditions such as stroke, spinal-cord injury, traumatic brain injury, or major trauma. Treatment is tailored to functional needs.

**Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome**

A severe inflammatory lung injury causing acute hypoxemic respiratory failure and diffuse lung opacities not fully explained by heart failure. Common triggers include sepsis, pneumonia, aspiration, trauma, and pancreatitis.

**Acute Sinusitis**

Acute inflammation of the mucosa of one or more paranasal sinuses, usually following a viral upper-respiratory infection. It causes nasal obstruction, purulent or discoloured discharge, facial pressure or pain, and reduced smell; persistent, severe, or worsening symptoms may indicate acute bacterial rhinosinusitis or a complication.

**Synonyms:**

Sinusitis, Acute

**Acute Stress Disorder**

A trauma-related mental-health condition beginning after exposure to actual or threatened death, serious injury, or sexual violence and lasting from three days to one month. Symptoms may include intrusive memories, avoidance, negative mood, dissociation, and increased arousal; professional assessment and

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support are recommended.

### **Acute Tubular Necrosis**

Most common cause of intrinsic AKI resulting from ischemic or nephrotoxic injury to tubular epithelial cells. Ischemic ATN develops from prolonged prerenal states. Nephrotoxic ATN results from direct injury by aminoglycosides, amphotericin B, cisplatin, contrast, and myoglobin.

### **Acute Viral Illness**

A short-duration illness caused by a virus. Symptoms depend on the affected organ system and may include fever, fatigue, cough, vomiting, diarrhea, or rash.

### **Acute-On-Chronic Liver Failure**

Acute deterioration of pre-existing chronic liver disease associated with organ failure and high short-term mortality. It is commonly precipitated by infection, alcohol-related hepatitis, bleeding, or other acute insults and requires urgent multidisciplinary management.

### **Adam's Apple**

The common name for the laryngeal prominence, the visible projection at the front of the neck formed by the angle where the two laminae of the thyroid cartilage meet.

### **Adaptive Equipment**

Devices that help individuals with disabilities perform daily activities independently. Examples: reachers, dressing sticks, button hooks, ergonomic utensils, grab bars, shower chairs, wheelchairs, walkers, canes. Selection based on individual needs and goals. Occupational therapy assessment recommended.

### **Adaptive Immunity**

Antigen-specific immunity mediated principally by B and T lymphocytes. It develops after antigen exposure, generates immunologic memory, and includes humoral responses from B-cell antibodies and cellular responses from T cells.

### **Addiction**

A chronic, relapsing brain disorder characterized by compulsive substance use or behavior despite harmful consequences. It involves changes in brain reward, motivation, and memory circuits, leading to impaired control over the behavior. Treatment often combines medication, behavioral therapy, and social support.

### **Addison Disease**

Primary adrenal insufficiency resulting from destruction or dysfunction of the adrenal cortex, leading to deficiency of cortisol, aldosterone, and adrenal androgens.

### **Addisonian Crisis**

Life-threatening emergency resulting from acute cortisol deficiency in patients with adrenal insufficiency. Precipitated by infection, trauma, surgery, or abrupt discontinuation of chronic glucocorticoid therapy.

### **Adduction**

Movement of a body part toward the body's midline.

### **Adductor Muscles**

A group of muscles on the medial thigh that adduct (pull toward the midline) the hip: adductor longus, adductor brevis, adductor magnus, gracilis, and pectineus. Innervated by the obturator nerve (L2-L4); adductor magnus also receives tibial nerve (sciatic). Adductor longus is a common site of athletic injury ('groin strain').

### **Adenocarcinoma**

A malignant tumor arising from glandular epithelial tissue, forming gland-like structures. The most common type of carcinoma, occurring in organs such as the colon, breast, lung, pancreas, and prostate.

### **Adenocarcinoma Of The Colon**

A malignant gland-forming epithelial tumor of the colon, commonly presenting with altered bowel habits, occult bleeding, anemia, or an obstructing mass.



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## Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor of glandular tissue, most commonly of the salivary glands, characterized by slow growth, perineural spread, and late recurrence.

## Adenoidectomy

The surgical removal of the pharyngeal tonsils (adenoids), which are lymphoid tissue structures located in the nasopharynx, and it is commonly performed in children for obstructive sleep apnea, chronic nasal obstruction, recurrent otitis media, and chronic rhinosinusitis that is refractory to medical management.

## Adenoids

Lymphoid tissue in the posterior wall and roof of the nasopharynx, part of Waldeyer ring of pharyngeal lymphoid tissue. Enlarged adenoids (adenoidal hypertrophy) in children cause nasal obstruction, mouth breathing, snoring, obstructive sleep apnea, serous otitis media (eustachian tube obstruction), and facial changes ('adenoid facies').

## Adenoma

A benign tumour arising from glandular or gland-like epithelial tissue. Some adenomas, particularly certain colorectal adenomas, can develop dysplasia and progress to carcinoma.

## Adenoma-Carcinoma Sequence

Established model of stepwise colorectal carcinogenesis progressing from normal epithelium through adenomas to carcinoma over ten to fifteen years.

## Adenomatous Polyp

A benign gland-forming polyp, most commonly in the colon, that may contain dysplasia and can progress through the adenoma–carcinoma sequence. Tubular, villous, and tubulovillous types are recognized.

## Adenomyosis

A condition in which endometrial glands and stroma are present within the myometrium (uterine muscle). Most common in multiparous women in their 40s and 50s. Presents with heavy menstrual bleeding

(menorrhagia), severe dysmenorrhea, chronic pelvic pain, and uterine enlargement.

## Adenovirus

A non-enveloped DNA virus that causes respiratory infections, conjunctivitis, gastroenteritis, and cystitis. Adenoviruses are highly stable in the environment and can cause outbreaks in closed populations. The virus has over 50 serotypes with different tissue tropisms. Diagnosis is made by PCR, antigen detection, or viral culture.

## Adenovirus Infection

Infection with an adenovirus, commonly causing sore throat, cough, fever, conjunctivitis, diarrhea, or vomiting. Most infections are self-limited, but severe respiratory or disseminated disease can occur in infants and people with weakened immunity. Treatment is usually supportive, with medical assessment for breathing difficulty, dehydration, or severe illness.

## Adenovirus Vaccine

A vaccine used primarily to prevent adenovirus types 4 and 7 among selected military personnel. It is an oral, live vaccine and is not part of routine vaccination for the general public. Vaccine use and eligibility depend on current public-health recommendations.

## ADHD

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder is a neurodevelopmental disorder involving persistent inattention and/or hyperactivity and impulsivity that impair functioning. Symptoms begin in childhood, occur in more than one setting, and are classified as predominantly inattentive, predominantly hyperactive-impulsive, or combined presentation.

## Adherence

The extent to which a person follows an agreed treatment plan, including prescribed medicines and other care. Adherence may be affected by cost, adverse effects, treatment complexity, health beliefs, or difficulty accessing care.

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### **Adherence (Geriatric)**

Adherence to an agreed treatment plan in an older adult, including medicine use, appointments, and recommended self-care. Cognitive impairment, polypharmacy, adverse effects, cost, and support needs may affect adherence.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Adhesive Capsulitis**

A condition causing progressive shoulder pain and stiffness due to inflammation and fibrosis of the glenohumeral joint capsule. See Frozen Shoulder.

### **Adhesive Tape**

A material used to secure dressings, devices, or tubing to the skin. It is available in paper, cloth, plastic, and other forms.

### **Adie Tonic Pupil**

Uncommon cause of anisocoria, a benign parasympathetic denervation of the iris sphincter and ciliary muscle, typically unilateral in young women, idiopathic or associated with diabetes, herpes zoster, or autoimmune neuropathy.

### **Adipocere (Grave Wax)**

Waxy, grayish-white substance formed postmortem in warm, moist, anaerobic environments (water, damp soil) by the hydrolysis and hydrogenation of body fat into free fatty acids; retards putrefaction and preserves anatomical details for months to years.

#### **Synonyms:**

Grave Wax

### **Adiponectin**

A hormone produced mainly by adipose tissue that influences fatty-acid metabolism, insulin sensitivity, and inflammatory responses.

### **Adipose Tissue**

A specialized connective tissue composed mainly of adipocytes that store energy as triglycerides. It provides thermal insulation, cushioning for organs,

and endocrine regulation through hormones and signaling molecules such as leptin and adiponectin.

### **Adjustment Disorder**

Emotional or behavioral symptoms in response to an identifiable stressor occurring within three months of the onset of the stressor. The symptoms are disproportionate to the severity of the stressor and cause significant distress or impairment. It resolves within six months of the termination of the stressor.

### **Adjustment Disorder With Anxiety**

An emotional or behavioral response to an identifiable stressor that causes distress or impairment but does not meet criteria for another mental disorder.

### **Adjuvant Therapy**

Additional treatment after primary treatment to reduce recurrence risk. Examples: chemotherapy after surgery.

### **ADL Training**

Training for activities of daily living: dressing, bathing, grooming, feeding, toileting. Adaptive techniques, equipment.

### **Administered Activity**

The measured amount of radioactive material given to a patient for imaging or therapy, usually expressed in becquerels. It should be prescribed and recorded with the radionuclide, radiopharmaceutical, route, date, and time of administration.

### **Adolescent Health**

The health and wellbeing of young people (10-19 years), addressing the physical, psychological, and social transitions of puberty and adolescence.

### **Adolescent Confidentiality And Consent**

The principles governing private healthcare discussions with adolescents and their ability to participate in medical decisions. The exact rules for confidentiality, consent, and parental involvement depend on age, capacity, local law, and safeguarding concerns.



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## Adoptive Cell Therapy

A personalized cellular immunotherapy in which a patient's own lymphocytes are expanded or engineered ex vivo and reinfused to attack the tumor; examples include tumor-infiltrating lymphocyte (TIL) therapy and chimeric antigen receptor (CAR) T-cell therapy.

## ADP (Adenosine Diphosphate)

A nucleotide composed of adenine, ribose, and two phosphate groups. Formed by hydrolysis of ATP ( $\text{ATP} \rightarrow \text{ADP} + \text{P}_i$ ,  $\Delta G^\circ = -30.5 \text{ kJ/mol}$ ). Serves as the immediate precursor for ATP synthesis via oxidative phosphorylation (mitochondrial ATP synthase), substrate-level phosphorylation (glycolysis, TCA cycle), and photophosphorylation.

### Synonyms:

Adenosine Diphosphate

## Adrenal Cortex Physiology

The adrenal cortex produces steroid hormones in three zones: the zona glomerulosa produces mineralocorticoids, mainly aldosterone; the zona fasciculata produces glucocorticoids, mainly cortisol; and the zona reticularis produces adrenal androgens. Secretion is regulated by the renin-angiotensin system, plasma potassium, and the hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis.

## Adrenal Cortical Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor arising from the adrenal cortex. It may be functional, producing excess adrenal hormones, or nonfunctional.

## Adrenal Crisis

An acute, life-threatening manifestation of severe adrenal insufficiency. Causes: primary (Addison disease), secondary (pituitary failure), or tertiary (exogenous corticosteroid withdrawal). Precipitants: systemic infection, trauma, surgery, or abrupt steroid cessation.

## Adrenal Gland

Paired endocrine glands atop each kidney (suprarenal), composed of cortex and medulla. Cortex (three zones): zona glomerulosa (aldos-

terone, mineralocorticoids), zona fasciculata (cortisol, glucocorticoids), zona reticularis (androgens). Medulla: chromaffin cells secrete epinephrine and norepinephrine (catecholamines).

## Adrenal Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the adrenal gland most commonly occurring in critically ill patients with sepsis, coagulopathy, or anticoagulation therapy. Bilateral adrenal hemorrhage may cause acute adrenal insufficiency with circulatory collapse. Waterhouse-Friderichsen syndrome: adrenal hemorrhage associated with meningococcal sepsis.

## Adrenal Hyperplasia

Enlargement or overgrowth of adrenal tissue that may increase production of adrenal hormones. Causes include congenital adrenal hyperplasia, chronic stimulation by ACTH, and some adrenal tumors. Symptoms depend on the hormone affected and may include abnormal genital development, early puberty, excess body hair, high blood pressure, or electrolyte disturbances.

## Adrenal Insufficiency

Deficient production of cortisol by the adrenal cortex classified as primary adrenal insufficiency or Addison disease from adrenal gland destruction, secondary from pituitary ACTH deficiency, and tertiary from chronic exogenous glucocorticoid suppression of the hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis.

## Adrenal Medulla Physiology

The adrenal medulla produces catecholamines primarily epinephrine and norepinephrine in response to sympathetic nervous system activation. Epinephrine accounts for approximately eighty percent and norepinephrine approximately twenty percent of catecholamine output.

## Adrenal Myelolipoma

A usually benign adrenal tumor composed of mature fat and blood-forming tissue. It is often found incidentally on imaging and causes no symptoms, but larger lesions may produce mass effect or bleeding. Management depends on size, symptoms, growth,

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and diagnostic certainty.

### **Adrenal Tumors**

Tumors arising in the adrenal cortex or medulla may be benign or malignant and may or may not produce hormones. Evaluation uses clinical assessment, hormone testing when indicated, and imaging to assess size and appearance; treatment depends on the diagnosis, hormone secretion, symptoms, growth, and risk of malignancy.

### **Adrenal Venous Sampling**

Interventional radiology procedure for lateralizing aldosterone secretion in primary hyperaldosteronism. Catheterization of both adrenal veins allows measurement of aldosterone and cortisol levels to calculate selectivity index confirming successful cannulation and lateralization ratio.

### **Adrenalectomy**

Surgical removal of one or both adrenal glands, performed for selected adrenal tumors, severe hormone excess, or other localized disease. Removal of one gland may leave adequate hormone production; bilateral removal causes permanent adrenal insufficiency and requires lifelong hormone replacement and emergency-steroid planning.

### **Adrenocortical Carcinoma**

A rare malignant tumor of the adrenal cortex that may secrete cortisol, androgens, or aldosterone or be non-functional. Often large at diagnosis; treatment is en bloc resection, with mitotane for advanced disease.

### **Adrenocorticotrophic Hormone**

ACTH (corticotropin): a peptide hormone from the anterior pituitary (cleaved from POMC) that stimulates the adrenal cortex to produce cortisol (zona fasciculata) and adrenal androgens; regulated by hypothalamic CRH and cortisol negative feedback (circadian).

### **Adult Spinal Deformity**

Abnormal curvature or alignment of the spine in an adult, including scoliosis, kyphosis, or loss of

normal sagittal balance. It may cause back pain, nerve compression, difficulty walking, or functional disability.

### **Adult Still's Disease**

A systemic inflammatory disorder characterized by recurrent high fevers, arthritis or joint pain, a transient salmon-colored rash, sore throat, and possible involvement of other organs.

### **Adult-Onset Still Disease**

A systemic inflammatory disorder beginning in adulthood, characterized by high-spiking fevers, arthritis or joint pain, a transient salmon-pink rash, sore throat, and possible liver, spleen, heart, or blood-clotting complications.

### **Advance Care Planning**

A process of discussing and documenting a person's healthcare values and preferences for possible future illness, including designation of a surrogate decision-maker when appropriate.

### **Advance Directive**

Legal document expressing healthcare wishes. Components: living will (treatment preferences), durable power of attorney for healthcare (surrogate decision-maker). Should be reviewed periodically, discussed with surrogate and healthcare team.

### **Advanced Cancer**

Cancer that has grown beyond its original site. It may be locally advanced when it has invaded nearby tissues or metastatic when it has spread to distant organs.

### **Advanced Cardiovascular Life Support**

A standardized set of advanced resuscitation measures for cardiac arrest and other life-threatening cardiovascular emergencies. It includes high-quality CPR, defibrillation when indicated, airway management, medicines, and treatment of reversible causes.

### **Advanced Maternal Age**

Maternal age of 35 years or older at the estimated

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time of delivery. It is associated with increased risks of some chromosomal conditions and pregnancy complications.

### **Adverse Drug Event**

Harm related to the use of a medication, including harm caused by an adverse drug reaction, medication error, overdose, or inappropriate use.

### **Adverse Drug Reaction**

An adverse drug reaction is any noxious or unintended response to a drug that occurs at doses used for prophylaxis, diagnosis, or therapy.

### **Adverse Event**

Any untoward medical occurrence during or after a treatment or intervention, whether or not it is considered causally related to that treatment. Severity, seriousness, expectedness, and relatedness are assessed separately.

### **Aerobe**

A microorganism that requires molecular oxygen for growth or uses oxygen efficiently for energy production. Obligate aerobes are unable to grow without oxygen, whereas facultative organisms can grow with or without it.

### **Aerobic**

Requiring or involving molecular oxygen. In microbiology, aerobic organisms use oxygen for growth or energy production, either obligatorily or as one option among several; in physiology, aerobic metabolism uses oxidative phosphorylation in mitochondria to generate ATP from nutrients.

### **Aerophagy**

Excessive swallowing of air, also called aerophagia, which can lead to frequent belching, abdominal bloating, distension, and discomfort.

#### **Synonyms:**

aerophagia, which can lead to frequent.

### **Aesthetic Dentistry**

Dental care intended to improve the appearance of

the teeth, gums, or smile. Procedures may include tooth-colored restorations, veneers, whitening, or selected crowns.

### **Affective Flattening**

Markedly reduced outward expression of emotion, including limited facial expression, voice modulation, and gestures. It may occur in schizophrenia and other psychiatric or neurologic conditions.

### **AFP (Alpha-Fetoprotein)**

A protein produced mainly by the fetal liver. Maternal blood AFP is used in prenatal screening, and serum AFP may help evaluate selected liver and germ-cell tumors. Results are not diagnostic by themselves.

#### **Synonyms:**

Alpha-Fetoprotein

### **Afterload**

The resistance against which the ventricles must eject blood during systole. Left ventricular afterload is primarily determined by systemic vascular resistance (SVR); right ventricular afterload is determined by pulmonary vascular resistance (PVR). Afterload is estimated by blood pressure or calculated as wall stress.

### **Agar**

A gelatinous polysaccharide from red algae used to solidify culture media. Melting near 85°C and solidifying at 35–40°C, it remains solid at incubation temperatures and is largely undegraded by bacteria, enabling isolation of pure colonies on media such as blood, MacConkey, and Sabouraud agars.

### **Age-Related Macular Degeneration**

A degenerative disorder of the macula that can impair central vision in older adults. The dry form involves retinal and pigment-cell changes and may progress gradually; the neovascular form involves abnormal blood-vessel growth and may cause more rapid vision loss. Risk is influenced by age, smoking, family history, and other factors.

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### Age-Standardized Rate

A rate adjusted to a specified standard population age distribution so that populations with different age structures can be compared more fairly. It is commonly used for mortality, cancer, and disease-incidence comparisons.

### Ageism

Stereotyping, prejudice, or discrimination directed at people because of their age, which can impair access to appropriate medical care.

### Agensis Of The Corpus Callosum

Complete or partial absence of the corpus callosum, the major commissural fiber bundle connecting the cerebral hemispheres. May be isolated or associated with other CNS anomalies (Dandy-Walker, Chiari, heterotopias) and genetic syndromes (Aicardi, Andermann, acrocallosal syndromes).

### Ageusia

Complete loss of the sense of taste. Causes include viral infections, oral or nasal disease, head injury, damage to the facial or glossopharyngeal nerves, medications, chemotherapy, zinc deficiency, and neurologic disorders.

### Agglutination

The visible clumping of cells or particles caused by antibodies or other binding molecules linking antigens on their surfaces. It is used in blood-grouping and crossmatching, infectious-disease serology, and some laboratory identification tests.

### Aggregation, Platelet

The process by which activated platelets adhere to one another to form a primary platelet plug at a site of vascular injury. Platelet agonists such as ADP, thromboxane A<sub>2</sub>, and thrombin activate glycoprotein IIb/IIIa, which binds fibrinogen and links adjacent platelets.

### Aggression

Verbal or physical behavior intended to threaten, harm, or dominate another person or object. It may occur with mania, psychosis, personality dis-

orders, dementia, delirium, substance intoxication or withdrawal, traumatic brain injury, or severe frustration.

### Aggressive Cancer

A cancer that grows, invades, or spreads rapidly and may require prompt diagnosis and treatment. Aggressiveness depends on tumour biology, grade, stage, and response to therapy.

### Agility

The ability to move or change direction quickly while maintaining control and balance.

### Aging

Biological process of growing older, involving cumulative changes at molecular, cellular, tissue, organ levels.

### Agitation

A state of excessive motor activity, emotional excitement, and restlessness. In psychiatric settings, it may be a symptom of mania, psychosis, delirium, substance intoxication, or withdrawal.

### Agnathia

A rare congenital absence or severe underdevelopment of the mandible, maxilla, or both. It is usually part of a craniofacial developmental disorder and may cause profound facial deformity, airway obstruction, feeding difficulty, and impaired dentition.

### Agnosia

A higher-order neurological deficit characterized by the inability to recognize or process sensory stimuli (visual, auditory, tactile) despite intact primary sensory organs and pathways. Caused by focal lesions in specific cortical association areas (parietal, temporal, or occipital lobes).

### Agonist

A substance that binds to a receptor and activates it, producing a biological response. A full agonist can produce the receptor's maximum response, whereas a partial agonist produces a lower maximum re-

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sponse even when it occupies all available receptors.

### **Agonist-Antagonist**

A drug that has mixed pharmacological activity, acting as an agonist at one receptor type and an antagonist at another, or as a partial agonist at a single receptor.

### **Agoraphobia**

Anxiety disorder characterized by fear and avoidance of situations where escape might be difficult or help unavailable during a panic-like episode. Common feared situations include public transportation, open spaces, enclosed spaces, standing in line, being in crowds, and being outside the home alone.

### **Agranulocytosis**

A severe reduction or near-absence of circulating neutrophils, usually defined as an absolute neutrophil count below  $0.5 \times 10^9/L$ . It may be caused by medications, chemotherapy, autoimmune disease, infections, or bone-marrow disorders and presents with fever, sore throat, oral ulcers, or recurrent serious infections.

### **Agraphesthesia**

Inability to recognize numbers or letters traced on the skin, indicating a lesion of the contralateral parietal lobe (somatosensory association cortex, post-central gyrus). Tested with a blunt object on the palm or fingertip while the patient's eyes are closed.

### **Agraphia**

An acquired inability to write or express language in written form despite adequate education and motor ability. It may result from dominant-parietal or language-network lesions, especially stroke, traumatic brain injury, dementia, or brain tumors, and may occur with aphasia, alexia, or acalculia.

### **Aicardi-Goutieres Syndrome**

Rare autosomal recessive inflammatory disorder mimicking congenital viral infection. Characterized by cerebral calcifications, white matter disease, cerebral atrophy, and cerebrospinal fluid lymphocytosis. Presents with severe neurodevelopmental

impairment, seizures, and spasticity.

### **AIDS**

Acquired immunodeficiency syndrome: the advanced stage of HIV infection, defined by CD4 count  $<200$  cells/ $\mu L$  or the presence of AIDS-defining illnesses.

#### **Synonyms:**

Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS)

### **Air Abrasion**

Minimally invasive caries removal using abrasive particles. Alternative to drilling for small lesions.

### **Air Bronchogram**

A radiographic sign showing air-filled bronchi visible against opacified lung parenchyma, indicating that the airways remain patent while the surrounding alveoli are filled with fluid, pus, or cells.

### **Air Contaminants**

Solid, liquid, or gaseous substances in air that may harm health, such as particulate matter, fumes, gases, allergens, or microorganisms. Effects depend on the contaminant, concentration, and duration of exposure.

### **Air Embolism**

Entry of gas into the venous or arterial circulation, where it can obstruct blood flow and injure tissues. It may occur during medical procedures, trauma, or rapid changes in environmental pressure. Symptoms and treatment depend on the amount and location of gas and require urgent clinical assessment when significant embolism is suspected.

### **Air Polishing**

Removal of stains using air-abrasive device. Glycine or erythritol powder.

### **Air Quality**

The condition of air as determined by the concentration of pollutants such as particulate matter, ozone, nitrogen dioxide, and sulfur dioxide.



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## Airborne Disease

An infection that can spread through small suspended particles or aerosols under suitable conditions. Transmission depends on the organism, environment, ventilation, and duration of exposure.

## Airborne Precautions

Infection control measures used for pathogens transmitted through airborne droplet nuclei. Precautions include negative pressure rooms, N95 respirators, and restricted access. Airborne precautions are used for tuberculosis, measles, varicella, and disseminated herpes zoster.

## Airway Clearance Techniques

Physical or mechanical methods used to mobilize and remove airway secretions. Examples include directed coughing, breathing exercises, postural drainage, positive expiratory pressure, and high-frequency chest-wall oscillation. Selection depends on the disease, secretion burden, strength, and ability to cooperate.

## Airway Management

Airway management encompasses techniques and devices used to maintain ventilation and oxygenation in patients with compromised airways.

## Airway Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of airflow through the upper or lower respiratory tract. It may result from a foreign body, secretions, swelling, trauma, tumor, or loss of airway muscle tone and can cause stridor, wheeze, hypoxaemia, respiratory distress, or arrest.

## Airway Resistance

The opposition to airflow through the conducting airways, determined largely by airway radius and flow pattern. Bronchoconstriction, mucus, edema, and reduced elastic traction increase resistance; because resistance varies strongly with radius, small changes can markedly affect work of breathing.

## Akathisia

Subjective feeling of inner restlessness accompanied by a compulsive need to move, most commonly an

extrapyramidal side effect of antipsychotic drugs (typical and atypical neuroleptics), also seen with dopamine antagonists (metoclopramide), selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor withdrawal, and in Parkinson disease.

## Akinesia

Impairment or absence of voluntary movement, classically a hypokinetic feature of basal ganglia disorders such as Parkinson disease and related parkinsonian syndromes.

## Alagille Syndrome

An inherited disorder of Notch signaling that commonly affects the liver, heart, skeleton, eyes, and characteristic facial features. It is usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *JAG1* or, less often, *NOTCH2*.

## ALARA Principle

Radiation-protection principle requiring exposure to be kept as low as reasonably achievable while obtaining the necessary diagnostic or therapeutic information. Justification, optimization, collimation, shielding, time reduction, and increased distance support ALARA.

## Albinism (Oculocutaneous Albinism)

A group of inherited disorders that reduce melanin production in the skin, hair, and eyes. It may cause light pigmentation, reduced visual acuity, nystagmus, and increased sensitivity to sunlight; the severity depends on the genetic subtype.

### Synonyms:

Oculocutaneous Albinism

## Albright's Hereditary Osteodystrophy

A group of inherited features associated with abnormalities of *GNAS* signaling, including short metacarpal bones, a round facial appearance, short stature, and subcutaneous ossification. Some associated disorders also cause resistance to parathyroid hormone or other hormones.

## Alanine Aminotransferase (ALT)

An enzyme found mainly in liver cells that is released

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into the blood when hepatocytes are injured. Serum ALT is widely used to screen for and monitor liver disease and is interpreted together with aspartate aminotransferase, alkaline phosphatase, bilirubin, and the clinical context.

**Synonyms:**

ALT

**Albumin**

The main protein in blood plasma, produced by the liver. It helps maintain oncotic pressure and transports various substances, including hormones, fatty acids, and medications.

**Albumin-To-Creatinine Ratio**

The urinary albumin concentration standardized to urinary creatinine concentration, usually measured in a spot urine sample. Persistent albuminuria is a marker of kidney damage and is categorized as A1 (<30 mg/g), A2 (30–300 mg/g), or A3 (>300 mg/g) in commonly used CKD classification.

**Albuminuria**

Abnormally increased excretion of albumin in the urine, indicating disruption of the glomerular filtration barrier or another form of kidney disease. It is commonly detected with a urine albumin-to-creatinine ratio and classified as moderately or severely increased according to the quantity and persistence of excretion.

**Alcohol**

Ethanol, a psychoactive substance that can impair judgment and coordination and cause intoxication or dependence.

**Alcohol Dependency**

A chronic relapsing disorder characterized by compulsive ethanol use, loss of control over intake, and negative emotional state during withdrawal, leading to tolerance, dependence, and organ damage over time.

**Alcohol Intoxication**

Acute impairment caused by ethanol, which may produce disinhibition, impaired coordination,

slurred speech, vomiting, reduced consciousness, or respiratory depression. Severe intoxication can be life-threatening and requires assessment of breathing, circulation, glucose, trauma, and other substances.

**Alcohol Swab**

A single-use pad containing alcohol for cleaning intact skin before selected procedures. It should be used according to the product instructions and allowed to dry.

**Alcohol Use**

Consumption of alcoholic beverages. Health effects depend on amount, frequency, pattern, and individual risk.

**Alcohol Use Disorder**

A problematic pattern of alcohol use leading to significant impairment or distress. Severity is classified as mild (2–3 criteria), moderate (4–5 criteria), or severe (6 or more criteria).

**Alcohol Withdrawal**

A syndrome that may occur after abrupt cessation or substantial reduction of prolonged heavy alcohol use. Symptoms can include tremor, anxiety, sweating, nausea, hallucinations, seizures, or delirium; onset and severity vary, and severe withdrawal requires urgent medical care.

**Alcoholic Cardiomyopathy**

Dilated cardiomyopathy caused by chronic excessive alcohol consumption, one of the most common reversible causes of dilated cardiomyopathy. Direct toxic effect of ethanol and its metabolite acetaldehyde on cardiomyocytes. Presentation is identical to other dilated cardiomyopathies.

**Alcoholic Ketoacidosis**

A high-anion-gap metabolic acidosis caused by prolonged heavy alcohol use, poor nutritional intake, and vomiting. It typically presents with abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, dehydration, and tachypnea, often with a normal or low blood glucose concentration.



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## Alcoholic Neuropathy

A length-dependent peripheral neuropathy associated with chronic excessive alcohol use and nutritional deficiency, especially thiamine deficiency. It causes burning pain, numbness, paraesthesia, and weakness, most prominently in the feet and lower legs.

## Aldosterone

A mineralocorticoid hormone produced by the zona glomerulosa of the adrenal cortex, the final effector of the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system (RAAS).

## Alexia

An acquired inability to comprehend written language despite intact vision and otherwise preserved language function, usually caused by stroke or other lesions affecting the dominant-hemisphere reading networks. When reading is impaired but writing remains possible, the pattern is called alexia without agraphia.

## Algor Mortis

Post-mortem cooling of the body following death until it reaches ambient environmental temperature. Serves as one of the physical estimators of the post-mortem interval (time since death).

## Aliasing Artifact

An ultrasound display artifact in which blood flow exceeds the selected velocity scale and appears to reverse direction. It can be reduced by increasing the scale or changing the imaging settings.

## Alkaline Phosphatase

A group of enzymes that catalyze the hydrolysis of phosphate esters at alkaline pH, found in high concentrations in the liver, bone, placenta, and intestinal mucosa. Elevated serum levels occur in obstructive liver disease, bone disorders including Paget disease and fractures, pregnancy, and certain malignancies.

## Alkalosis

A metabolic (elevated bicarbonate) or respiratory

(low PaCO<sub>2</sub>) disturbance that raises arterial pH above 7.45. Metabolic alkalosis: vomiting/NG suction (HCl loss), diuretics, mineralocorticoid excess, hypokalemia, and alkali ingestion—compensated by hypoventilation; chloride-responsive vs. chloride-resistant distinguishes causes.

## Allele

Alternative form of a gene at a particular locus. Individuals inherit two alleles for each gene (one from each parent). Alleles can be dominant, recessive, or codominant.

## Allergen

A substance capable of causing an allergic immune response in a susceptible person. Common allergens include proteins in foods, pollens, medicines, animal dander, insect venom, and natural rubber.

## Allergen Immunotherapy

Treatment that gives gradually increasing doses of a specific allergen by injection or under the tongue to reduce allergic sensitivity. It may be used for selected allergic rhinitis, conjunctivitis, asthma, or insect-venom allergy.

## Allergic Bronchopulmonary Aspergillosis

A hypersensitivity reaction to *Aspergillus fumigatus* in asthma or CF patients. Causes central bronchiectasis, elevated total IgE, and eosinophilia. Treatment includes corticosteroids and itraconazole.

## Allergic Conjunctivitis

An inflammatory condition of the conjunctiva mediated by IgE-dependent mast cell degranulation in response to environmental allergens, characterized by bilateral ocular itching, tearing, conjunctival injection, and eyelid edema.

## Allergic Dermatitis

An inflammatory skin reaction caused by an immune response to an external allergen, most commonly allergic contact dermatitis. It is a delayed, T-cell-mediated hypersensitivity reaction that typically develops after prior sensitization.

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## Allergic Reactions

Immune reactions to substances that are usually harmless, such as foods, medicines, pollens, or insect venom. They may be immediate or delayed and can range from localized symptoms to anaphylaxis.

## Allergic Rhinitis

An IgE-mediated inflammatory response of the nasal mucosa to inhaled allergens, causing sneezing, nasal congestion, clear rhinorrhea, nasal itching, and often conjunctival symptoms. Management may include allergen avoidance, intranasal corticosteroids, antihistamines, and allergen immunotherapy when indicated.

## Allergic Rhinitis (Hay Fever)

Allergies occur when the immune system overreacts to harmless environmental substances such as pollen, dust mites, mold, or pet dander. Hay fever (allergic rhinitis) specifically involves nasal symptoms like sneezing, congestion, and itchy eyes triggered by airborne allergens.

**Synonyms:**  
Hay Fever

## Allergies

Immune reactions to normally harmless substances such as foods, pollens, medicines, insect venom, or animal dander. Reactions range from localized rhinitis or dermatitis to life-threatening anaphylaxis.

## Allergy Testing

Identification of IgE-mediated allergic sensitization. Skin prick test (SPT): allergen extract applied to skin via lancet, read after 15 min (wheal >3mm = positive). Intradermal test: more sensitive, used when SPT negative but suspicion remains.

## Allodynia

Pain caused by a stimulus that is normally not painful, such as light touch or gentle pressure. It may occur with neuropathic, nociplastic, or other pain conditions.

## Allograft

Tissue transplanted between genetically different individuals of the same species. Allografts may provoke immune rejection and require appropriate donor screening, processing, and, in some settings, immunosuppression.

## Allosteric Regulation

The regulation of enzyme activity by the binding of an effector molecule at a site other than the active site (allosteric site), causing a conformational change that alters the enzyme's activity. Allosteric enzymes typically have multiple subunits with cooperative binding kinetics (sigmoidal rather than hyperbolic velocity curves).

## Alogia

Poverty of speech or poverty of content of speech, a negative symptom of schizophrenia. It manifests as brief, empty replies to questions, reduced spontaneous speech, and lack of elaboration. It reflects dysfunction in the mesocortical dopamine pathway and is less responsive to antipsychotic medications than positive symptoms.

## Alopecia

The general medical term for loss of hair from the scalp or body, rather than a single specific disease. Causes include disorders of the hair follicle, immune disease, hormones, medicines, systemic illness, or physical injury. Androgenetic alopecia (male- or female-pattern hair loss) is common and is associated with genetic susceptibility and androgen, particularly dihydrotestosterone (DHT), effects. Alopecia areata is an autoimmune, usually non-scarring, patchy hair-loss disorder that may progress to alopecia totalis (entire scalp) or universalis (whole body).

## Alopecia Areata

A common, autoimmune, non-scarring hair loss disorder affecting approximately 1 to 2 percent of the population worldwide, with a lifetime risk of 2 percent, occurring equally across sexes and ethnicities, with peak onset between 15 and 29 years.

**Synonyms:**  
AA (Alopecia Areata) Patchy Hair Loss (Alopecia

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Areata)

### Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency

An autosomal codominant genetic disorder caused by mutations in the SERPINA1 gene. It predisposes to early-onset panlobular emphysema (lower lobes), liver disease, and panniculitis. PiZZ genotype is most severe. Treatment includes AAT augmentation therapy and smoking avoidance.

### Alpha-Agonists

Medicines that stimulate alpha-adrenergic receptors. Depending on the receptor and tissue, they can constrict blood vessels, alter autonomic activity, or reduce aqueous-humor production in the eye. Their uses and adverse effects depend on the specific medicine and route.

### Alpha-Glucosidase Inhibitors

Oral glucose-lowering medications including acarbose, miglitol, and voglibose that delay carbohydrate digestion and glucose absorption in the small intestine by inhibiting brush border alpha-glucoside enzymes. Reduce postprandial glucose excursions without affecting fasting glucose significantly.

### Alpha-Ketoglutarate

A five-carbon intermediate of the citric acid cycle formed from isocitrate and converted to succinyl-CoA. It also serves as a carbon skeleton for amino acid metabolism and participates in oxidative deamination and cellular signaling.

### Alport Syndrome

Hereditary nephritis caused by mutations in type four collagen genes leading to progressive sensorineural hearing loss, ocular anomalies, and renal failure. X-linked form from COL4A5 mutations is the most common. Autosomal recessive and dominant forms exist.

### ALS

Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (motor neuron disease; Lou Gehrig disease) is the progressive neurodegenerative disease characterized by degeneration of upper and lower motor neurons controlling voluntary

movement. It causes progressive weakness, muscle wasting, fasciculations, spasticity, dysarthria, or dysphagia; sensation is usually relatively preserved, but respiratory muscles may eventually be affected.

### Altitude Illness

Acute mountain sickness (AMS): headache + 1 symptom (nausea, fatigue, dizziness, insomnia) at >2500m. HACE: AMS + ataxia/altered mental status (cerebral edema). HAPE: dyspnea at rest, cough, frothy sputum, crackles, hypoxemia (noncardiogenic pulmonary edema).

### Aluminum Phosphide

A highly toxic fumigant that releases phosphine gas when exposed to moisture or stomach acid. Poisoning can cause severe cardiovascular, respiratory, gastrointestinal, and metabolic effects and requires immediate emergency treatment and supportive intensive care.

### Alvarado Score

Clinical scoring system for acute appendicitis. Components (MANTRELS): Migration of pain (1), Anorexia (1), Nausea/vomiting (1), Tenderness in RLQ (2), Rebound pain (1), Elevated temperature (1), Leukocytosis (2), Left shift (1).

### Alveolar Bone

Bone surrounding and supporting tooth roots. Resorbs with tooth loss. Maintained by function. Bone grafting may be needed for implants.

### Alveolar Gas Equation

$PAO_2 = (FiO_2 \times (P_{atm} - PH_2O)) - (PaCO_2 / R)$ .  
 $P_{atm} = 760 \text{ mmHg}$ ,  $PH_2O = 47 \text{ mmHg}$ ,  $R = 0.8$ .  
Allows calculation of A-a gradient.

### Alveolar Ventilation

The volume of fresh air reaching the alveoli per minute, representing the portion of minute ventilation that participates in gas exchange. Calculated as (tidal volume - dead space volume) x respiratory rate. Normal alveolar ventilation is approximately 4-5 L/min.

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### Alveolar Ventilation Equation

The relationship between alveolar ventilation and arterial carbon-dioxide tension, approximately  $\text{PaCO}_2 = 0.863$  times carbon-dioxide production divided by alveolar ventilation. It explains why reduced effective ventilation causes hypercapnia.

### Alveolus

The terminal air sac (200-300 microns) where gas exchange occurs. Approximately 300-500 million per lung, providing 70 m<sup>2</sup> surface area. Wall: type I pneumocytes (95% surface, thin for diffusion), type II pneumocytes (5%, secrete pulmonary surfactant reducing surface tension), alveolar macrophages (dust cells, phagocytosis).

### Alzheimer Disease

A progressive neurodegenerative disorder characterized pathologically by amyloid-beta plaques, tau neurofibrillary pathology, and neuronal loss. It most commonly presents with insidious impairment of episodic memory followed by broader cognitive and functional decline.

### Amalgam

Restorative material composed of mercury alloyed with silver, tin, copper, and other metals. Properties: strong, durable, cost-effective. Concerns: mercury toxicity debates, aesthetic limitations. Placement: requires cavity preparation, condensation, carving. Removal: sectioning, cooling to prevent mercury vapor.

### Amaurosis Fugax

Transient monocular vision loss lasting seconds to minutes, classically described as a curtain descending over the field, caused by retinal or optic nerve ischemia.

### Ambiguous Genitalia

External genital anatomy that does not have typical male or female features, usually because of a difference in sex development. Evaluation includes examination, chromosome and hormone testing, pelvic or abdominal imaging, and assessment for congenital adrenal hyperplasia.

### Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring

Measurement of blood pressure at regular intervals, usually over twenty-four hours, with a portable cuff worn during normal activities and sleep. It detects white-coat and masked hypertension, evaluates nighttime blood-pressure patterns, and helps confirm hypertension diagnosed in the clinic.

### Amblyopia

A developmental reduction in vision caused by abnormal visual input during early childhood, without a sufficient structural explanation. It commonly results from misalignment, unequal focusing power, or obstruction of vision in one eye.

### Ambu Bag

A self-inflating manual resuscitation bag used with a mask or airway device to provide positive-pressure ventilation.

### Amebiasis

Infection with the protozoan parasite *Entamoeba histolytica*, acquired mainly by ingestion of faecally contaminated food or water. It may be asymptomatic or cause amoebic colitis with abdominal pain, diarrhoea, or dysentery, and can spread through the portal circulation to produce a liver abscess.

### Amebic Liver Abscess

A focal collection of necrotic material in the liver caused by *Entamoeba histolytica*, usually following intestinal infection. It commonly causes fever, right-upper-quadrant pain, and tender hepatomegaly; diagnosis is supported by imaging and serology.

### Amelanotic Melanoma

A variant of melanoma that lacks significant melanin production, presenting as a pink, red, or flesh-coloured papule or nodule rather than a typical dark lesion. Its paucity of pigment can delay diagnosis, making it a diagnostic challenge. Histopathology with immunohistochemical markers confirms the diagnosis.

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## Amelia

A rare congenital anomaly characterized by complete absence of one or more limbs. It may occur alone or as part of a genetic or developmental syndrome. Prenatal imaging can identify the anomaly and help assess associated abnormalities.

## Ameloblastoma

Locally aggressive odontogenic tumor. Multicystic radiolucency in posterior mandible. High recurrence rate. Treatment: surgical resection with margins.

## Amelogenesis

The formation and maturation of tooth enamel by ameloblasts during tooth development.

## Amelogenesis Imperfecta

A group of inherited disorders in which enamel formation is abnormal, causing enamel that may be thin, poorly mineralized, weak, or easily worn on most or all teeth.

## Amenorrhea

Absence of menstruation. Primary amenorrhea: no menarche by age 15 with normal secondary sexual development, or by age 13 without. Secondary amenorrhea: absence of menses for three cycles or six months in women with prior menstruation.

## Amino Acid

An organic molecule containing an amino group, a carboxyl group, a hydrogen atom, and a variable side chain attached to a central carbon. Amino acids are the building blocks of proteins; cells use some also in energy metabolism and other biochemical pathways.

## Amino Acid Catabolism

The breakdown of amino acids after protein digestion, with the amino group removed and the carbon skeleton metabolized for energy or gluconeogenesis/ketogenesis. Transamination: amino groups are transferred to alpha-ketoglutarate, forming glutamate, by aminotransferases requiring pyridoxal phosphate (PLP, vitamin B6) as a cofactor.

## Aminoglycoside Nephrotoxicity

Kidney damage caused by aminoglycoside antibiotics, characterized by acute tubular necrosis. Nephrotoxicity is caused by accumulation of aminoglycosides in the proximal tubular cells. The risk is increased with prolonged therapy, high doses, concurrent nephrotoxic drugs, and renal impairment.

## Aminoglycoside Ototoxicity

Damage to the inner ear caused by aminoglycoside antibiotics, resulting in hearing loss and vestibular dysfunction. Ototoxicity is caused by accumulation of aminoglycosides in the inner ear, damaging hair cells. The risk is increased with prolonged therapy, high doses, concurrent ototoxic drugs, and renal impairment.

## Aminoglycosides

A class of bactericidal antibiotics that bind irreversibly to the 30S ribosomal subunit, causing misreading of messenger RNA and inhibiting protein synthesis. They include gentamicin, tobramycin, amikacin, and streptomycin.

## Amiodarone-Induced Skin Discoloration

A slate-grey to bluish hyperpigmentation of sun-exposed skin caused by long-term amiodarone therapy, due to deposition of the drug and its metabolites in dermal macrophages. It is dose-related, more pronounced in photodistributed areas, and may be partially reversible upon drug cessation.

## Amiodarone-Induced Thyroid Dysfunction

Thyroid abnormalities occurring in approximately fifteen to twenty percent of patients on amiodarone due to the high iodine content of the molecule. Type one results from iodine-induced increased thyroid hormone synthesis in patients with underlying thyroid disease. Type two results from destructive thyroiditis.

## Amiodarone-Induced Vortex Keratopathy

Whorl-like corneal epithelial deposits caused by amiodarone accumulation, appearing as golden-brown verticillata on slit-lamp examination, usually



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asymptomatic but reversible upon drug discontinuation.

### **Ammonia**

A nitrogen-containing waste product produced during protein metabolism and normally converted to urea by the liver. Elevated blood ammonia may occur with liver failure, urea-cycle disorders, some medicines, or other metabolic conditions.

### **Amnesia**

Loss or impairment of memory that is greater than ordinary forgetting. It may affect the ability to form new memories (anterograde amnesia), recall past events (retrograde amnesia), or both.

### **Amniocentesis**

A procedure in which a needle is used to obtain amniotic fluid for genetic, chromosomal, infectious, or other prenatal testing. It is usually performed after the first trimester when clinically indicated; risks and benefits depend on the reason for testing and gestational age.

### **Amnion**

The innermost fetal membrane, lining the amniotic cavity and containing the amniotic fluid. A thin, avascular membrane composed of a single layer of cuboidal epithelium overlying a basement membrane and connective tissue. The amnion produces and resorbs amniotic fluid. It fuses with the chorion by 12-14 weeks.

### **Amniotic Band Syndrome**

A spectrum of congenital anomalies caused by strands of a ruptured amniotic membrane that constrict or entangle developing fetal parts. Effects range from ring-like limb constrictions, swelling, or loss of digits to facial and body-wall disruptions; severity varies widely, and management depends on the structures involved.

### **Amniotic Fluid**

The clear to pale-yellow fluid surrounding the fetus within the amniotic sac. Early in pregnancy it is derived largely from maternal plasma; later, fetal

urine and lung fluid are major sources, and the fetus continuously swallows and recycles it.

### **Amniotic Fluid Embolism**

A rare obstetric emergency involving sudden respiratory or cardiovascular collapse and often severe coagulopathy during labor, delivery, or shortly afterward. It requires immediate supportive and multidisciplinary treatment.

### **Amniotic Fluid Index**

An ultrasound estimate of amniotic-fluid volume obtained by dividing the uterus into four quadrants, measuring the deepest unobstructed vertical pocket in each quadrant, and adding the measurements. Interpretation uses gestational-age and practice-specific thresholds to identify unusually low or high fluid volume.

### **Amoebiasis**

Infection caused by the protozoan parasite *Entamoeba histolytica*, transmitted via the fecal-oral route (contaminated food or water).

### **Amoxicillin Rash In Infectious Mononucleosis**

A maculopapular, non-allergic rash that develops in up to 90 percent of patients with Epstein-Barr virus infectious mononucleosis who receive amoxicillin or ampicillin. The rash is often widespread and pruritic, and its presence does not indicate true penicillin allergy.

### **AMP (Adenosine Monophosphate)**

A nucleotide composed of adenine, ribose, and a single phosphate group. Formed by hydrolysis of ADP ( $\text{ADP} \rightarrow \text{AMP} + \text{Pi}$ ) or directly from ATP via adenylate kinase ( $2 \text{ADP} \rightleftharpoons \text{ATP} + \text{AMP}$ ).

#### **Synonyms:**

Adenosine Monophosphate

### **AMPK**

AMP-activated protein kinase. Energy sensor. Activated by AMP. Inhibits anabolism, stimulates catabolism.



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## Amputation

Surgical removal of a limb or part of a limb. The level may involve a digit, foot, lower leg, thigh, or hip, or a corresponding part of the upper limb. The level is selected according to tissue viability, function, and potential for rehabilitation.

## Amputation Stump

The remaining part of a limb after amputation. It must be monitored for wound healing, infection, poor circulation, neuroma pain, phantom-limb pain, and skin problems caused by prosthetic use. Care includes hygiene, compression or shaping when advised, progressive strengthening, and professional prosthetic and rehabilitation assessment.

## AMR (Antimicrobial Resistance)

The ability of a microorganism to survive or grow despite an antimicrobial medicine that would normally inhibit or kill it.

### Synonyms:

Antimicrobial Resistance

## Amygdala

Almond-shaped nucleus cluster in the anterior medial temporal lobe, part of the limbic system, primarily processing emotions (especially fear/anxiety). Receives thalamic/cortical sensory input; projects to hypothalamus, brainstem, and cortex for autonomic/behavioral fear responses.

## Amylase

An enzyme that breaks down starch and is produced mainly by the salivary glands and pancreas. Blood levels may rise in several conditions, including some pancreatic disorders.

## Amylase And Lipase

Digestive enzymes measured in blood when pancreatic disease is suspected. Lipase is generally more specific for pancreatic injury and remains elevated longer than amylase, but neither test alone diagnoses acute pancreatitis; results must be interpreted with symptoms and imaging.

## Amylin Analogues

Medicines that mimic amylin, a hormone released with insulin by pancreatic beta cells. Pramlintide slows gastric emptying, reduces post-meal glucagon secretion, and may be used with insulin in selected patients with diabetes.

## Amyloid PET

A positron-emission tomography scan using a tracer that binds to amyloid deposits in the brain. It can support evaluation of selected cognitive disorders but is interpreted with clinical assessment and other tests.

## Amyloid Purpura

Purpuric discoloration of the eyelids and periorbital skin (raccoon eyes) caused by cutaneous amyloid deposition, which weakens vessel walls and leads to extravasation of erythrocytes. It may be a sign of systemic amyloidosis, particularly AL amyloidosis, and warrants further workup including serum free light chains and tissue biopsy.

## Amyloidosis

A group of disorders characterized by the extracellular deposition of misfolded proteins that polymerize into insoluble fibrils with a distinctive beta-pleated sheet configuration. These fibrils bind Congo red dye and show characteristic apple-green birefringence under polarized light microscopy.

### Synonyms:

Amyloid Disease (Amyloidosis)

## Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis

Progressive neurodegenerative disorder affecting both upper and lower motor neurons, causing weakness, atrophy, fasciculations, and eventually respiratory failure. Most cases are sporadic (90 percent); 10 percent are familial. Average age of onset 55-60 years.

## Anabolism

The set of metabolic pathways that construct complex molecules from simpler precursors, requiring energy input (ATP, reducing equivalents NADPH). Examples: protein synthesis from amino acids, glyco-

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gen synthesis (glycogenesis), fatty acid synthesis (lipogenesis), cholesterol synthesis, nucleotide synthesis, gluconeogenesis.

### **Anaemia**

A condition in which the number of red blood cells or the hemoglobin concentration is below the normal range, reducing the oxygen-carrying capacity of the blood.

### **Anabolic Steroids**

Synthetic derivatives of testosterone used in selected medical conditions and misused for muscle building or performance enhancement. Nonmedical use can cause acne, infertility, testicular shrinkage, breast enlargement, mood disturbance, and cardiovascular disease, and sudden cessation may produce symptoms of hormone deficiency.

### **Anaerobe**

A microorganism that grows without molecular oxygen. Obligate anaerobes may be injured or killed by oxygen, while aerotolerant anaerobes tolerate oxygen but do not use it for energy production.

### **Anal Abscess**

Collection of pus in the perianal or ischiorectal space usually from infected anal glands. Presents with throbbing anal pain, swelling, fever, and difficulty sitting. Diagnosed clinically with tenderness and fluctuance. Treatment is incision and drainage under local anesthesia. Antibiotics are not routinely required for simple abscesses.

### **Anal Canal**

The terminal 3-4 cm of the gastrointestinal tract, extending from the anorectal junction (puborectalis/pectinate line) to the anal verge. Above the pectinate line: lined by columnar epithelium, innervated by autonomic nerves, draining to portal system, supplied by superior rectal artery.

### **Anal Cancer**

Malignant tumor of the anal canal or margin, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma associated with high-risk human papillomavirus infection. Presents

with bleeding, pain, or a mass; primary treatment is chemoradiation, with surgery reserved for residual or recurrent disease.

### **Anal Fissure**

Linear tear in the distal anal mucosa usually posterior in the midline. Presents with painful defecation and bright red blood on wiping or in the toilet. Associated with constipation, hard stools, and chronic diarrhea. The internal anal sphincter spasm perpetuates the fissure by reducing blood flow to the posterior midline.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anal Ulcer (Anal Fissure)

### **Anal Fistula**

Abnormal tract connecting the anal canal to the perianal skin usually following a drained abscess. Presents with recurrent drainage, pain, and pruritus. Parks classification categorizes fistulae by relationship to the sphincter muscles. Diagnosed by examination under anesthesia and MRI.

### **Anal Intercourse**

The insertion of the penis into the anus and rectum for sexual pleasure. The anal canal is rich in nerve endings, making it a sensitive erogenous zone. The rectum lacks natural lubrication, so artificial lubricants are essential to prevent mucosal trauma.

### **Anal Itching**

Pruritus around the anus. Common causes include irritation, moisture, dermatitis, hemorrhoids, infections, and occasionally pinworms or other disease. Gentle cleansing, keeping the area dry, and avoiding irritants may help; persistent, severe, bleeding, or painful symptoms require medical evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Itching Anal (Anal Itching) Pruritis Ani Rectal Itching

### **Analgesic**

A drug that relieves pain without producing loss of consciousness.

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## **Analgesic Nephropathy**

Chronic tubulointerstitial renal injury associated with prolonged or excessive use of analgesic medicines. It may cause impaired urinary concentration, sterile pyuria, haematuria, papillary necrosis, hypertension, and progressive chronic kidney disease.

## **Analysis Of Urine**

Laboratory examination of urine for cells, blood, protein, glucose, microorganisms, and other substances.

## **Analytic Sensitivity**

The smallest amount or concentration of an analyte that a laboratory method can reliably detect. It concerns measurement performance and differs from clinical sensitivity, which describes detection of disease in affected patients.

## **Anaphylactic Shock**

A severe, potentially life-threatening systemic hypersensitivity reaction characterized by rapid onset of multisystem involvement, primarily affecting the skin, respiratory tract, cardiovascular system, and gastrointestinal tract. See Anaphylaxis.

## **Anaphylaxis**

A severe, potentially life-threatening systemic hypersensitivity reaction characterized by rapid onset of multisystem involvement, primarily affecting the skin, respiratory tract, cardiovascular system, and gastrointestinal tract.

## **Anaphylaxis During Anesthesia**

A life-threatening systemic hypersensitivity reaction that may cause sudden hypotension, bronchospasm, cardiovascular collapse, and sometimes urticaria or flushing. Common perioperative triggers include neuromuscular-blocking agents, antibiotics, chlorhexidine, and latex.

## **Anaplasia**

A lack of differentiation, describing cells that have reverted to a more primitive, embryonic phenotype with loss of the specialized structural and functional

characteristics of their tissue of origin.

## **Aplasia**

Complete failure of development of an organ, tissue, or cell line, resulting in absence or severe deficiency of the expected structure. It may arise from congenital developmental abnormalities, inherited disorders, injury to a precursor cell population, or severe marrow suppression. Examples include aplastic anemia, renal aplasia, and aplasia of selected hematopoietic or lymphoid cell lines. Clinical effects depend on the affected structure and may range from an incidental anatomic finding to life-threatening organ failure.

## **Anaplastic Thyroid Cancer**

A rare, rapidly growing, and highly aggressive thyroid cancer that often presents as a large fixed neck mass with dysphagia or airway compromise. Prognosis is poor; management is usually palliative.

## **Anastomosis (Vascular)**

A surgical or natural connection between blood vessels that permits blood to flow from one vessel to another.

### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

## **Anastomotic Leak**

Breakdown of a surgical anastomosis in the gastrointestinal tract causing spillage of luminal contents into the peritoneal cavity. Presents with fever, tachycardia, abdominal pain, leukocytosis, and peritonitis. Diagnosed by CT with oral or rectal contrast showing extraluminal contrast or fluid collection.

## **Anatomical Axis**

An imaginary straight line around which a body part moves or rotates.

## **Anatomical Planes**

Hypothetical flat surfaces that pass through the body in anatomical position, used to slice the body for anatomical descriptions or medical imaging.

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## Anatomical Position

The standard reference position of the body used to describe anatomy, defined as standing erect, facing forward, with arms at the sides and palms facing forward.

## Anatomical Snuffbox

Triangular depression on the dorsal wrist, bounded by extensor pollicis longus medially and extensor pollicis brevis/abductor pollicis longus laterally. Floor contains the scaphoid, trapezium, and radial artery. Tenderness after a fall on an outstretched hand suggests scaphoid fracture. The radial artery pulse is palpable here.

## Anatomy

Study of body structure. Regions: head, neck, thorax, abdomen, pelvis, extremities. Systems: skeletal, muscular, nervous, circulatory, respiratory, digestive, urinary, reproductive, endocrine, immune.

## Anomalous Anatomy

A structural variation or congenital abnormality in the expected arrangement, number, origin, or course of an organ, vessel, duct, or other body structure. It may be incidental or clinically important during diagnosis, surgery, or interventional procedures.

## Anatomy Survey (Level II Ultrasound)

A comprehensive fetal ultrasound performed at 18–22 weeks to evaluate fetal anatomy and screen for structural anomalies.

### Synonyms:

Level II ultrasound; anatomy scan.

## Anemia In Pregnancy

Anemia occurring during pregnancy, commonly because of iron deficiency or the normal plasma-volume expansion of pregnancy. Assessment considers hemoglobin, mean corpuscular volume, iron status, folate, vitamin B12, bleeding, and other causes.

### Synonyms:

Gestational anemia; pregnancy-associated anemia.

## Apgar Score

A structured assessment of a newborn's appearance, pulse, grimace, activity, and respiration, usually recorded at 1 and 5 minutes after birth. It describes immediate adaptation after delivery and helps guide resuscitation; it is not a standalone diagnosis or long-term prognostic test.

### Synonyms:

Apgar assessment; newborn Apgar score.

## ANCA-Associated Vasculitis

A group of small-vessel vasculitides associated with antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibodies. Includes granulomatosis with polyangiitis (c-ANCA/PR3), microscopic polyangiitis (p-ANCA/MPO), and eosinophilic granulomatosis with polyangiitis (p-ANCA/MPO with asthma/eosinophilia).

## Ancillary Test (Pathology)

A test performed in addition to routine morphology to refine a pathologic diagnosis. Examples include IHC, flow cytometry, cytogenetics, molecular testing, special stains, and electron microscopy.

### Synonyms:

Pathology

## Ancylostoma (Hookworm)

Nematode infestation by *Ancylostoma duodenale* (Old World) or *Necator americanus* (New World), common in tropical and subtropical regions where sanitation is poor.

### Synonyms:

Hookworm

## Androgen Deficiency

Hypogonadism in males: reduced testosterone production causing symptoms and signs. Causes: primary (testicular—Klinefelter, mumps orchitis, chemotherapy, trauma) and secondary (pituitary/hypothalamic—prolactinoma, iron overload, pituitary lesions, opioids, obesity, aging).

## Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome

A difference of sex development in which the cells of a genetically male fetus cannot respond to andro-

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gens because of a defect in the androgen receptor. Affected individuals have typical female external genitalia and breast development but no uterus, and testes that may lie in the groin or abdomen; diagnosis and care require specialist endocrine and genetic assessment.

### **Androgenetic Alopecia**

The most common cause of hair loss, caused by progressive miniaturization of genetically susceptible hair follicles under androgen influence. Male pattern commonly affects the frontal hairline and vertex; female pattern commonly causes diffuse crown thinning with relative preservation of the frontal hairline.

### **Andropause**

Age-related testosterone decline in men. Symptoms: fatigue, decreased libido, depression. Treatment controversial.

### **Anejaculation**

Absence of ejaculation. Causes: neurological, surgical, pharmacological, psychological.

### **Anemia**

A reduction in the oxygen-carrying capacity of the blood, defined by a hemoglobin concentration below the normal range for age and sex: less than 13.5 g/dL in adult males, less than 12.0 g/dL in adult females.

#### **Synonyms:**

Blood Low Red Cell Count (Anemia)

### **Anemia (Cancer)**

Anemia occurring in a person with cancer, caused by the cancer itself, bleeding, inflammation, nutritional deficiency, or treatment. Evaluation identifies the cause; management may include treating the underlying problem, iron or other replacement, transfusion, or selected medicines.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer

### **Anemia Of Chronic Disease**

Anemia of inflammation. Normocytic or microcytic. Low iron, low TIBC, normal/high ferritin.

### **Anencephaly**

A fatal neural tube defect where the cerebral hemispheres and cranial vault fail to develop due to failed closure of the rostral neuropore during the fourth week of gestation. The brainstem and spinal cord are present, and reflex movements may occur, but there is no cognitive function.

### **Anergy**

State of T-lymphocyte non-responsiveness to nominal antigen despite prior sensitization, reflecting functional inactivation rather than cell death.

### **Anesthesia**

The use of medications to prevent sensation, particularly pain, during medical procedures or surgery.

### **Anesthesia For Coagulopathy**

Coagulopathy can increase bleeding risk during an operation or invasive procedure. Anesthetic planning considers the cause, bleeding history, platelet count, coagulation tests, fibrinogen, the procedure, and available correction or replacement therapies.

### **Anesthesia For Epilepsy**

Patients with epilepsy generally require continuation of antiseizure medication perioperatively because missed doses increase seizure risk. Propofol and benzodiazepines are anticonvulsant; high concentrations of some volatile agents may produce epileptiform activity.

### **Anesthesia For Hemophilia**

Hemophilia A results from factor VIII deficiency and hemophilia B from factor IX deficiency. Perioperative care is coordinated with hematology and uses factor replacement or, in selected mild hemophilia A cases, desmopressin.

### **Anesthesia For Neurosurgery**

Neuroanesthesia aims to maintain cerebral perfusion



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pressure (CPP = mean arterial pressure minus intracranial pressure), optimize brain relaxation, and minimize secondary brain injury. Induction agents (propofol, etomidate) reduce cerebral metabolic rate and intracranial pressure.

### **Anesthesia For Pheochromocytoma**

Anesthetic care for pheochromocytoma requires control of catecholamine effects before surgery, careful management of blood pressure and heart rate, and preparation for rapid hemodynamic changes.

### **Anesthesia For Porphyria**

Anesthetic care in acute porphyria requires avoidance of medicines known to precipitate attacks and attention to nutrition, pain, and metabolic stability. The specific drug plan should be checked against a current porphyria-safety reference.

### **Anesthesia Gas Analyzers**

Anesthesia gas analyzers measure delivered and exhaled concentrations of oxygen, carbon dioxide, and volatile anesthetic agents. The oxygen analyzer measures inspired oxygen concentration; pulse oximetry measures peripheral hemoglobin oxygen saturation.

### **Anesthesia Informatics**

Anesthesia informatics integrates electronic health records, decision support systems, and data analytics into clinical practice. Automated documentation reduces charting time. Clinical decision support alerts for drug interactions and dosing errors. Big data analytics identify patterns in anesthesia outcomes.

### **Anesthesia Machine**

The anesthesia machine delivers precise mixtures of oxygen, air, and volatile anesthetics to the patient.

### **Anesthesia Monitoring**

Continuous assessment of vital functions during anesthesia, typically including oxygenation, ventilation, circulation, temperature, and depth of anesthesia as clinically indicated.

### **Anesthesia Pharmacogenomics**

Anesthesia pharmacogenomics studies genetic variations affecting drug response. Pseudocholinesterase deficiency causes prolonged succinylcholine paralysis. CYP2D6 polymorphisms affect codeine metabolism to morphine. Malignant hyperthermia susceptibility is linked to RYR1 gene mutations.

### **Aneuploidy**

The presence of an abnormal number of chromosomes in a cell, with either extra or missing copies of whole chromosomes, such as trisomy 21. It results from errors in cell division and is a major cause of miscarriage, congenital syndromes, and chromosomal disorders identified by prenatal testing.

### **Aneurysm**

A localized weakening and enlargement of a blood vessel. Aneurysms may occur in arteries or, rarely, veins and may rupture, dissect, or form emboli depending on their location and cause.

### **Aneurysm Clip**

Surgical clip occluding aneurysm neck. Materials: titanium, stainless steel. Indications: intracranial aneurysm. Placed via craniotomy. Complications: clip migration, vessel occlusion, rebleeding.

### **Aneurysm Coils**

Flexible coils, often made of platinum, placed inside an aneurysm to promote clotting and reduce blood flow into the aneurysm.

### **Aneurysm Repair**

Surgical or catheter-based treatment that excludes or replaces a weakened, dilated section of a blood vessel when the risk of rupture or other complications justifies intervention.

### **Angelman Syndrome**

A genetic disorder caused by loss of function of the UBE3A gene on chromosome 15 (maternal deletion or paternal uniparental disomy). Features: severe intellectual disability, absent speech, seizures, ataxia, and frequent laughter. Characteristic happy demeanor with hand-flapping movements.



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## Angina Pectoris

Chest discomfort caused by myocardial ischemia without infarction. Stable angina occurs predictably with exertion and resolves with rest. Unstable angina occurs at rest or with minimal exertion and is an acute coronary syndrome. Prinzmetal (variant) angina occurs at rest due to coronary vasospasm.

## Angiodysplasia

Dilated, fragile blood vessels in the gastrointestinal mucosa or submucosa, often occurring in the right colon of older adults. They may cause intermittent or recurrent gastrointestinal bleeding and anemia.

## Angioedema

Rapid swelling of the deep dermis/subcutaneous and submucosal tissues (lips, eyelids, tongue, throat, hands, GI tract) due to mast cell mediator release (histamine—allergic/idiopathic, urticaria associated) or bradykinin-mediated (hereditary angioedema—C1 esterase inhibitor deficiency; ACE-inhibitor-induced).

## Angiogenesis

Formation of new blood vessels. Tumors induce angiogenesis for growth. Targeted by anti-angiogenic drugs (bevacizumab).

## Angiography

Invasive imaging of blood vessels by injecting contrast material under fluoroscopy. Coronary angiography (cardiac catheterization): assesses coronary artery stenosis, guides PCI. Cerebral angiography: evaluates aneurysms, AVMs, and vasculitis. Peripheral angiography: evaluates PAD and guides intervention.

## Angiomyolipoma

A benign renal tumor composed of blood vessels, smooth muscle, and fat; it is associated with tuberous sclerosis and may cause retroperitoneal hemorrhage.

## Angioplasty

A procedure that widens a narrowed blood vessel, usually with a balloon and sometimes a stent. It is

used most often for coronary or peripheral arterial disease.

## Angioplasty Balloon (Vascular)

An inflatable catheter balloon used to widen a narrowed blood vessel or expand a stent.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Angiosarcoma

A rare, aggressive malignant tumor of blood vessel or lymphatic endothelial cells. Common sites include skin, breast, liver, and bone. Treatment typically involves wide surgical excision with chemotherapy and radiation.

## Angiotensin Converting-Enzyme Inhibitor

A class of antihypertensive medications that block the conversion of angiotensin I to angiotensin II by inhibiting the angiotensin-converting enzyme, thereby reducing vasoconstriction and aldosterone secretion. Used to treat hypertension, heart failure, and diabetic nephropathy.

## Angiotensin Receptor Blockers

A class of cardiovascular drugs that selectively block the angiotensin II type 1 receptor, preventing the binding of angiotensin II and its effects including vasoconstriction, aldosterone secretion, and sympathetic activation.

## Anhedonia

The inability to experience pleasure from activities that were previously enjoyable. It is a core symptom of major depressive disorder and a negative symptom of schizophrenia. It is mediated by dysfunction in the brain's reward circuitry, particularly the mesolimbic dopamine system.

## Anhidrosis

Absent or greatly reduced sweating. It may result from nerve damage, skin disease, dehydration, medications, or inherited conditions. Inability to sweat can cause dangerous overheating, especially during exercise or hot weather.

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## Animal-Assisted Therapy

A structured intervention in which trained animals are incorporated into care to support defined therapeutic goals. It may be used to support engagement, mood, communication, or activity when appropriate safeguards are in place.

## Anion Gap

A calculated estimate of unmeasured serum anions, commonly sodium minus chloride and bicarbonate. An increased anion gap supports the presence of unmeasured acids in metabolic acidosis, but interpretation must account for albumin concentration and laboratory method.

## Anisocoria

Unequal pupil size. It may be physiologic or caused by disorders of the eye, autonomic nerves, or brain; sudden anisocoria with headache, eye pain, or neurologic symptoms requires urgent assessment.

## Anisocytosis

Increased variation in red blood cell size on a peripheral blood film (e.g., macrocytes with microcytes together), not a diagnosis in itself. Derived from the Greek "anisokytosis" (unequal cells). Quantified by an elevated red cell distribution width (RDW).

## Ankle Arthroplasty

Surgical replacement of the ankle joint with a prosthesis, usually for severe symptomatic ankle arthritis. Suitability depends on deformity, bone quality, infection risk, activity level, and the condition of the surrounding joints.

## Ankle Dislocation

Complete displacement of the ankle joint surfaces, usually resulting from a high-energy injury and often accompanied by a fracture, ligament damage, or neurovascular compromise. It causes severe pain, deformity, and inability to bear weight. The joint requires urgent reduction, imaging, and immobilization, with surgical management when instability or associated fractures demand it.

### Synonyms:

Dislocated Ankle (Ankle Dislocation)

## Ankle Fractures

Ankle fractures: Weber classification (fibular fracture relative to syndesmosis): A (below syndesmosis, stable), B (at syndesmosis, variable stability), C (above syndesmosis, unstable). Lauge-Hansen: supination-external rotation (SER, most common), supination-adduction, pronation-external rotation, pronation-abduction.

## Ankle Joint

Uniaxial hinge synovial joint between distal tibia, lateral malleolus, and superior talus, allowing dorsiflexion/plantarflexion. Medial (deltoid) ligament resists eversion; lateral complex resists inversion. The ankle mortise provides bony stability.

## Ankle Pain

Pain in or around the ankle, commonly caused by sprain, fracture, tendinitis, arthritis, bursitis, or infection. Inability to bear weight, deformity, marked swelling, or fever requires prompt assessment.

## Ankle Sprain

An injury to the ligaments surrounding the ankle joint, most commonly involving the lateral ligament complex (anterior talofibular ligament [ATFL, most commonly injured], calcaneofibular ligament [CFL], and posterior talofibular ligament [PTFL]) from an inversion mechanism.

## Ankle Swelling

Enlargement around the ankle caused by injury, inflammation, infection, venous disease, lymphatic problems, or fluid retention. One-sided sudden swelling with pain, warmth, or shortness of breath may indicate a blood clot or infection and requires urgent assessment; swelling after trauma may require evaluation for fracture.

## Ankle-Brachial Index

The ratio of ankle systolic blood pressure to brachial systolic blood pressure. A low result supports peripheral arterial disease, while a very high result may indicate noncompressible arteries.

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### Ankyloglossia (Tongue-Tie)

Short or thick lingual frenulum restricting tongue movement. May cause breastfeeding difficulties, speech problems, oral hygiene issues. Treatment: frenotomy (simple release) or frenuloplasty.

#### Synonyms:

Tongue-Tie

### Ankylosing Spondylitis

A chronic, progressive inflammatory disease primarily affecting the axial skeleton (sacroiliac joints and spine), characterized by inflammation at entheses (where tendons, ligaments, and joint capsules insert into bone), leading to new bone formation, syndesmophyte development, and eventual vertebral fusion (bamboo spine).

#### Synonyms:

Arthritis Ankylosing Spondylitis (Ankylosing Spondylitis)

### Ankylosis

Abnormal stiffness or fusion of a joint. In dentistry, it may refer to fusion of a tooth root to the surrounding bone.

### Annihilation

Positron-electron annihilation producing two 511 keV photons in opposite directions.

### Annular Pancreas

A congenital anomaly where a ring of pancreatic tissue completely or partially encircles the second portion of the duodenum, causing duodenal obstruction. It results from failure of the ventral pancreatic bud to completely rotate around the duodenum during embryogenesis.

### Anodontia

Complete absence of teeth. Rare, associated with ectodermal dysplasia.

### Anophthalmia

Congenital absence of the eye due to failure of optic vesicle development, often associated with syndromes (e.g., SOX2 mutations). Diagnosis by ab-

sence of globe on imaging or clinical examination; management requires early socket expansion and prosthetic fitting for orbital and facial development.

### Anorectal Abscess

A localized collection of pus in the tissues around the anus or rectum, usually caused by infection of an anal gland. It commonly causes severe anal pain, swelling, fever, and difficulty sitting. Prompt incision and drainage is the standard treatment.

### Anorectal Malformation

A congenital abnormality in which the anus or rectum does not develop normally or does not connect appropriately to the perineum. Types vary in anatomy and severity and usually require specialist surgical assessment.

### Anorectal Manometry

Measurement of pressures in the anal canal and rectum to assess sphincter function and rectal sensation. A pressure-sensing catheter is inserted into the rectum and slowly withdrawn through the anal canal. Measures resting and squeeze pressures reflecting internal and external sphincter function respectively.

### Anorexia

Loss of appetite, distinct from anorexia nervosa (the eating disorder).

### Anorexia Nervosa

An eating disorder characterized by restriction of energy intake, intense fear of weight gain, and distorted body image. Highest mortality of any psychiatric disorder. Features: emaciation, lanugo, bradycardia, hypotension, amenorrhea, and electrolyte abnormalities. Diagnosis by DSM-5 criteria.

#### Synonyms:

Eating Disorders, Anorexia

### Anorgasmia

Persistent or recurrent delay in, or absence of, orgasm following a normal sexual excitement phase.

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## Anoscopy

Examination of the anal canal with a short lighted instrument called an anoscope. It is used to evaluate rectal bleeding, hemorrhoids, fissures, fistulas, and other anorectal disorders.

## Anosmia

Complete loss of the sense of smell. Causes include post-viral olfactory dysfunction, chronic rhinosinusitis with polyps, head trauma, neurodegenerative disease, congenital disorders such as Kallmann syndrome, medications, and toxic exposure.

## Anosognosia

Denial or unawareness of one's own neurologic deficit, classically hemiplegia following a nondominant (right) parietal lobe lesion. Associated with right middle cerebral artery strokes and sometimes with neglect of the left side of space.

## Anovulation

Failure to release an egg from the ovary during the menstrual cycle. It may cause irregular or absent periods, infertility, or abnormal bleeding and can result from hormonal disorders, excessive exercise, low body weight, stress, or polycystic ovary syndrome.

## Anoxia

Complete absence of oxygen supply to tissues, distinguished from hypoxia (reduced oxygen). Anoxia causes rapid cell death, particularly in highly aerobic tissues (brain, heart, kidneys).

## Antacids

Medications that neutralise gastric acid, providing rapid symptomatic relief in dyspepsia, gastroesophageal reflux, and peptic ulcer disease. Commonly contain aluminium hydroxide, magnesium hydroxide, calcium carbonate, or sodium bicarbonate.

## Antecubital Fossa

Triangular depression on the anterior elbow, bounded laterally by brachioradialis, medially by pronator teres, and superiorly by a line connecting the epicondyles. Floor formed by brachialis and

supinator. Contains biceps tendon, brachial artery, and median nerve. Primary site for venipuncture and blood pressure measurement.

## Antemortem Injury

Injury inflicted upon a body prior to death, characterized microscopically and macroscopically by physiological tissue responses including hemorrhage, blood clotting, inflammatory cell infiltration, tissue edema, and active healing reactions (differentiating it from postmortem artifact).

## Antenatal

The period before birth, also called prenatal. The medical supervision and screening provided to pregnant women to monitor the health of the mother and fetus, detect complications early, and provide health education.

**Synonyms:**  
prenatal.

## Antepartum Fetal Surveillance

The monitoring of fetal well-being in the third trimester for high-risk pregnancies. Methods: fetal kick counts (daily maternal counting of fetal movements), non-stress test (NST), biophysical profile (BPP, AFI, fetal tone, movement, breathing), and Doppler (umbilical artery, MCA).

## Antepartum Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the genital tract after the threshold of fetal viability and before birth. Important causes include placenta previa, placental abruption, vasa previa, and local cervical or vaginal lesions; maternal stabilization and fetal assessment are priorities.

## Anterior

Relating to the front of the body or positioned closer to the front.

## Anterior Chamber Angle

The anterior chamber angle is the anatomical region where the cornea and iris meet, and it contains the trabecular meshwork, the primary drainage structure for aqueous humor from the eye.

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### **Anterior Cruciate Ligament Injury**

Tear of the ACL, a common sports injury (non-contact deceleration, pivoting, or hyperextension). Presents with a pop, immediate swelling (hemarthrosis), and giving way of the knee. Positive Lachman test (most sensitive), anterior drawer test, and pivot shift test.

### **Anterior Cruciate Ligament Tear**

ACL tear: common knee injury, often non-contact pivoting sports. Symptoms: popping sound, swelling, instability, inability to continue play. Diagnosis: Lachman test, anterior drawer, MRI. Treatment: surgical reconstruction (autograft/allograft), rehabilitation.

### **Anterior Pituitary**

The glandular portion of the pituitary that secretes ACTH, TSH, growth hormone, prolactin, FSH, and LH in response to hypothalamic releasing hormones. Its hormones regulate adrenal, thyroid, growth, lactation, and reproductive function.

### **Anterior Tibial Artery**

Arises from the popliteal artery, passes through the anterior intermuscular septum to the anterior compartment, continuing to the ankle as the dorsalis pedis artery. Supplies anterior leg and dorsal foot muscles. Palpable anterior to the lateral malleolus as the dorsalis pedis pulse.

### **Anterior Uveitis**

Anterior uveitis, also known as iritis or iridocyclitis when the ciliary body is involved, is inflammation of the anterior segment of the eye involving the iris and/or ciliary body, and it is the most common form of uveitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

iritis or iridocyclitis when the ciliary body is.

### **Anterior/Posterior Drawer Test**

A clinical test of knee stability. Anterior displacement assesses the anterior cruciate ligament, and posterior displacement assesses the posterior cruciate ligament.

### **Anthrax**

A serious infectious disease caused by the gram-positive bacterium *Bacillus anthracis*, which forms highly resistant spores that can persist in the environment for decades, and it is primarily a zoonotic disease of herbivores (cattle, sheep, goats) that can be transmitted to humans through contact with infected animals or their products.

### **Anthropometry**

Body measurements: weight, height, BMI, waist, hip, skinfold thickness. Assessment of nutritional status and body composition.

### **Anti-CCP**

An autoantibody against citrullinated proteins. It supports the diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis and may be associated with a more erosive disease course, but it must be interpreted with the clinical findings.

### **Anti-CCP Antibody**

A blood antibody directed against citrullinated proteins. It can support assessment of rheumatoid arthritis and may be detectable before joint symptoms, but a positive or negative result is not diagnostic by itself.

### **Anti-Citrullinated Peptide Antibody**

An autoantibody against citrullinated proteins that may support a diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis. Its significance depends on the clinical context.

### **Anti-DsDNA Antibody**

An autoantibody directed against double-stranded DNA. It supports the diagnosis of systemic lupus erythematosus and may be associated with disease activity, particularly kidney involvement; results are interpreted with other findings.

### **Anti-GBM Disease**

Autoimmune disease with antibodies against alpha-3 chain of type IV collagen in glomerular and alveolar basement membranes. Presents with crescentic GN and pulmonary hemorrhage (Goodpasture syndrome). Linear IgG deposits on immunofluorescence. Treatment requires emergent plasmapheresis,



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cyclophosphamide, and corticosteroids.

### **Anti-IgE Therapy**

Omalizumab is a monoclonal antibody that binds free IgE, preventing it from binding to mast cells and basophils. It reduces allergic inflammation and is approved for moderate-to-severe persistent allergic asthma. It reduces exacerbations and the need for oral corticosteroids. It is administered by subcutaneous injection every 2–4 weeks.

### **Anti-IL4 Receptor Therapy**

Dupilumab is a monoclonal antibody blocking the IL-4 receptor alpha subunit, inhibiting both IL-4 and IL-13 signaling. It is approved for moderate-to-severe asthma with eosinophilic phenotype or oral corticosteroid dependence. It reduces exacerbations and improves lung function.

### **Anti-IL5 Therapy**

Treatment with monoclonal antibodies that block interleukin-5 signaling or its receptor, thereby reducing eosinophil production or survival. It is used for selected eosinophilic diseases, including some forms of severe asthma.

### **Anti-Inflammatory**

A medicine or other treatment that reduces inflammation.

### **Anti-MDA5 Dermatomyositis**

A clinically distinct subtype of dermatomyositis associated with anti-melanoma differentiation-associated gene 5 antibodies, characterised by skin-predominant disease, mechanic's hands, and a high risk of rapidly progressive interstitial lung disease.

### **Anti-Mullerian Hormone**

A hormone produced by granulosa cells of ovarian follicles. It is measured in selected fertility and reproductive evaluations, but it does not by itself determine fertility.

### **Anti-Reflux Surgery**

An operation intended to reduce reflux of stomach

contents into the esophagus, usually by reinforcing the gastroesophageal junction. It may be considered for selected patients with gastroesophageal reflux disease or a hiatal hernia.

### **Antianginal**

A class of medications used to prevent or relieve angina pectoris (chest pain from myocardial ischemia).

### **Antiarrhythmic**

A drug used to treat or prevent abnormal cardiac rhythms. Drug classes act mainly on sodium channels, sympathetic stimulation, potassium channels, or calcium channels; selection depends on the rhythm and the patient's clinical condition.

### **Antibiogram**

A periodic summary of antimicrobial susceptibility patterns of bacterial isolates from a hospital or laboratory. Guides empiric antibiotic therapy by showing local resistance patterns (e.g., % of *E. coli* susceptible to TMP-SMX). Updates annually.

### **Antibiotic**

A substance that kills or slows the growth of bacteria.

### **Antibiotic Cycling**

A strategy in which the preferred antibiotic for a particular clinical use is changed at planned intervals. It is intended to limit selection of resistant organisms, although its benefit depends on local conditions and implementation.

### **Antibiotic De-Escalation**

The process of narrowing antimicrobial spectrum based on microbiological results and clinical response. De-escalation aims to reduce selective pressure for resistance while maintaining therapeutic efficacy.

### **Antibiotic Mixing**

A strategy in which different antibiotics are assigned concurrently to different patients with the same



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indication. It is intended to reduce uniform selection pressure for resistance in a patient population.

### **Antibiotic Resistance**

Bacteria resisting antibiotic effects. Mechanisms: enzymatic degradation, target modification, efflux pumps, membrane permeability. Driven by antibiotic overuse.

#### **Synonyms:**

Resistance Antibiotic (Antibiotic Resistance)

### **Antibiotic Resistance Genes**

Genes that encode mechanisms conferring resistance to antibiotics. These genes can be located on chromosomes, plasmids, or transposons. Major resistance genes include *mecA* (methicillin resistance in *S. aureus*), *vanA/vanB* (vancomycin resistance in *Enterococcus*), and *blaKPC* (carbapenem resistance).

### **Antibiotic Stewardship**

Coordinated efforts to use antibiotics appropriately by selecting the right medicine, dose, route, and duration while reducing unnecessary treatment and resistance.

### **Antibodies**

Immunoglobulin proteins produced by B cells that bind to specific antigens. There are five classes: IgG (most abundant), IgM (first produced), IgA (mucosal immunity), IgE (allergic responses), and IgD. Antibodies neutralise pathogens, opsonise for phagocytosis, activate complement, and mediate antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity.

### **Anticholinergic Burden**

The cumulative effect of taking multiple medications with anticholinergic properties. It can cause dry mouth, constipation, urinary retention, blurred vision, confusion, and delirium, especially in elderly patients. Many psychiatric medications (TCAs, first-generation antipsychotics, some antihistamines) have anticholinergic effects.

### **Anticholinergic Cognitive Burden Scale**

A medication-review tool that estimates the total

anticholinergic load of a patient's medicines. It supports risk assessment and deprescribing but does not replace individualized clinical judgment.

### **Anticoagulant Monitoring**

Laboratory assessment used to measure the effect or safety of an anticoagulant. The appropriate test depends on the drug and may include aPTT, anti-Xa activity, INR, or measurements of kidney function and blood counts.

### **Anticoagulation**

Treatment that reduces blood clot formation by inhibiting the coagulation system. It is used for conditions such as venous thromboembolism and selected cardiac or vascular disorders.

### **Anticodon**

A three-nucleotide sequence at one end of transfer RNA that base-pairs with a complementary messenger RNA codon during translation, ensuring the correct amino acid is incorporated into the growing polypeptide.

### **Anticonvulsant Mood Stabilizers**

Antiepileptic drugs used as mood stabilizers in bipolar disorder. Valproate (divalproex) is effective for acute mania and rapid cycling. Carbamazepine is effective for acute mania but has numerous drug interactions via CYP3A4 induction. Lamotrigine is effective for bipolar depression prevention but not acute mania.

### **Anticonvulsants**

Medications used to prevent or control seizures in epilepsy and other seizure disorders.

### **Antidiabetic**

A class of medications used to manage diabetes mellitus by lowering blood glucose levels through various mechanisms.

### **Antidiarrheal**

A drug that reduces the frequency or volume of diarrhea. Some antidiarrheals should be avoided

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when there is bloody diarrhea, high fever, suspected invasive infection, or ileus.

### **Antidiuretic Hormone**

A hypothalamic hormone released from the posterior pituitary in response to increased plasma osmolality or reduced effective circulating volume. It increases collecting-duct water permeability through V2 receptors and promotes vasoconstriction through V1 receptors.

### **Antidiuretic Hormone Physiology**

Antidiuretic hormone also known as vasopressin is synthesized in the supraoptic and paraventricular nuclei of the hypothalamus and stored in the posterior pituitary. Released in response to increased serum osmolality detected by hypothalamic osmoreceptors and decreased blood volume detected by baroreceptors.

#### **Synonyms:**

vasopressin is synthesized in the supraoptic and

### **Antidiuretic Hormone Resistance**

Impaired renal response to vasopressin, causing excessive production of dilute urine and polydipsia. Causes include lithium, hypercalcemia, hypokalemia, chronic kidney disease, and inherited defects of the vasopressin receptor or aquaporin pathway.

### **Antidote**

Substance that counteracts poison toxicity. Specific: naloxone (opioids), flumazenil (benzodiazepines), N-acetylcysteine (acetaminophen), digoxin immune Fab (digoxin), chelators (EDTA, deferoxamine, dimercaprol), atropine + pralidoxime (organophosphates), methylene blue (methemoglobinemia), cyanide antidote kit (nitrite + thiosulfate).

### **Antiemetic**

A medication that prevents or treats nausea and vomiting.

### **Antiepileptic Drugs**

Medications used to prevent and control seizures by modulating neuronal excitability through various

mechanisms. They can be classified by their primary mechanism of action.

### **Antifungal**

A drug used to treat fungal infections.

### **Antifungal Drug Classes**

Major classes of antifungal agents include polyenes (amphotericin B), azoles (fluconazole, voriconazole), echinocandins (caspofungin, micafungin), and allylamines (terbinafine). Polyenes bind to ergosterol in fungal cell membranes. Azoles inhibit ergosterol synthesis. Echinocandins inhibit cell wall synthesis.

### **Antifungal Prophylaxis**

The use of antifungal agents to prevent invasive fungal infections in high-risk patients. Common indications include prolonged neutropenia, hematopoietic stem cell transplantation, and advanced HIV infection. Fluconazole, posaconazole, and micafungin are used for prophylaxis.

### **Antifungal Resistance**

The ability of fungi to withstand the effects of antifungal agents. Resistance can be intrinsic or acquired. Azole resistance occurs through efflux pumps and target mutations. Echinocandin resistance occurs through FKS gene mutations. Amphotericin B resistance is rare.

### **Antigen**

A molecule or molecular structure specifically recognized by an antibody, B-cell receptor, or T-cell receptor. An immunogen is an antigen capable of inducing an immune response; antigenicity and immunogenicity are related but not synonymous properties.

### **Antigen Detection Test**

A diagnostic assay that identifies a pathogen-derived antigen in a clinical specimen using a specific antibody or related binding reagent. It is generally rapid but may be less sensitive than nucleic-acid amplification, especially when organism burden is low.

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## Antigen-Presenting Cell

Specialized immune cells that process protein antigens and display peptide fragments bound to Major Histocompatibility Complex (MHC) molecules on their surface for recognition by T-cell receptors. Professional APCs: dendritic cells (most potent for naive T cells), macrophages, and B cells.

## Antigenic Drift

The gradual accumulation of point mutations in viral surface antigens (hemagglutinin, neuraminidase) during replication, allowing influenza viruses to evade pre-existing antibodies and cause recurrent seasonal epidemics. Drift is continuous and selected by host immunity; it is why the seasonal vaccine is updated annually.

## Antigenic Shift

A major, abrupt change in the antigenic structure of a virus (especially influenza A) resulting from genetic reassortment between different strains (e.g., human and avian viruses) infecting the same cell.

## Antigenic Variation

The process by which pathogens change their surface proteins to evade immune recognition. Antigenic drift: gradual changes in surface proteins. Antigenic shift: major changes through reassortment of genome segments. Influenza virus demonstrates both mechanisms. Trypanosomes and Plasmodium also use antigenic variation.

## Antigout

A class of medications used to treat gout by reducing uric acid levels or controlling acute inflammation.

## Antihistamine

A drug that blocks histamine receptors. H1 antihistamines treat allergic rhinitis, urticaria, pruritus, and (older sedating agents) insomnia and motion sickness. First-generation (diphenhydramine, chlorpheniramine): CNS-penetrant—sedating, anticholinergic (dry mouth, urinary retention, confusion in elderly).

## Antihypertensive

A medicine used to lower blood pressure. Classes include ACE inhibitors, angiotensin-receptor blockers, calcium-channel blockers, thiazide-type diuretics, beta-blockers, and other agents. Selection depends on blood pressure, kidney function, cardiovascular disease, pregnancy, and other clinical factors.

## Antihypertensives In Pregnancy

Medications used to treat hypertension in pregnancy.

## Antimicrobial

A general term for antibiotics and other drugs that fight microscopic organisms in the body, such as bacteria, viruses, fungi, and parasites.

## Antimicrobial Adverse Effects

Side effects associated with antimicrobial agents. Beta-lactams can cause allergic reactions. Fluoroquinolones can cause tendon rupture and QT prolongation. Aminoglycosides can cause nephrotoxicity and ototoxicity. Azole antifungals can cause hepatotoxicity.

## Antimicrobial Desensitization

A procedure that administers gradually increasing doses of an antimicrobial to temporarily induce tolerance in a person with a documented or strongly suspected immediate allergy. It may be considered when that antimicrobial is clinically necessary and suitable alternatives are not available.

## Antimicrobial Dosing Optimization

Strategies to ensure antimicrobial agents achieve therapeutic concentrations at the site of infection. Optimization includes appropriate drug selection, dosing interval, route of administration, and duration of therapy. Extended or continuous infusion of beta-lactams may improve outcomes. Weight-based dosing is important for many agents.

## Antimicrobial Drug Interactions

Interactions between antimicrobial agents and other medications. Fluoroquinolones chelate divalent cations. Macrolides inhibit CYP3A4. Rifampin is

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a potent enzyme inducer. Azole antifungals inhibit CYP3A4.

### **Antimicrobial Hypersensitivity Reactions**

Immune-mediated reactions to antimicrobial agents that may range from a mild rash to life-threatening anaphylaxis. The reaction depends on the drug, the patient, and the type of immune response.

### **Antimicrobial Pharmacodynamics**

The relationship between antimicrobial drug concentrations and their effect on microorganisms. Time-dependent antibiotics (beta-lactams) are most effective when concentrations remain above the MIC. Concentration-dependent antibiotics (aminoglycosides) are most effective with high peak concentrations.

### **Antimicrobial Pharmacokinetics**

The absorption, distribution, metabolism, and elimination of antimicrobial agents. Pharmacokinetics varies by drug class, patient factors, and disease state. Renal impairment affects elimination of many antibiotics. Hepatic impairment affects metabolism of many antifungals.

### **Antimicrobial Resistance**

Microorganisms becoming resistant to antibiotics. Major global health threat. Prevention: appropriate antibiotic use, infection control.

### **Antimicrobial Resistance Mechanisms**

Biological processes that allow microorganisms to survive antimicrobial exposure, including drug inactivation, modification of the drug target, reduced permeability, and active drug efflux.

### **Antimicrobial Resistance Surveillance**

The systematic monitoring of antimicrobial resistance patterns in clinical isolates. Surveillance programmes track resistance rates over time and guide empiric therapy. National and international networks share resistance data.

### **Antimicrobial Stewardship**

Coordinated actions that promote appropriate antimicrobial selection, dose, route, and duration to improve patient outcomes and limit resistance, adverse effects, and unnecessary cost.

### **Antimicrobial Susceptibility Testing**

Laboratory methods used to estimate how susceptible a microorganism is to antimicrobial agents. Methods include disk diffusion, broth microdilution, and automated systems. Results are interpreted using standardized breakpoints and can help guide antimicrobial therapy.

### **Antineoplastic**

A medicine or other treatment that inhibits the growth or survival of abnormal cells, especially cancer cells.

### **Antinuclear Antibody**

ANA: autoantibodies against nuclear components (DNA, histones, ribonucleoproteins, etc.), detected by immunofluorescence (HEp-2 cells), reported with pattern (homogeneous, speckled, nucleolar, centromere) and titer.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antinuclear Antibodies

### **Antioxidant**

A substance that limits oxidation by reacting with oxidizing molecules or free radicals.

### **Antiparasitic**

A drug used to treat infections caused by parasites (protozoa and helminths). Antiprotozoals: metronidazole (Giardia, amebiasis, trichomoniasis), tinidazole, chloroquine and artemisinin combinations (malaria), pyrimethamine (toxoplasmosis), pentamidine, and nifurtimox (Chagas).

### **Antiparkinson**

A class of medications used to manage Parkinson disease symptoms by restoring dopaminergic activity or modulating other neurotransmitter systems.

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### Antiparkinsonian

A drug used to treat Parkinson disease and drug-induced parkinsonism.

### Antiphospholipid Antibodies

Include lupus anticoagulant (prolongs phospholipid-dependent coagulation tests), anticardiolipin antibodies (IgG/IgM), and anti-beta-2-glycoprotein I antibodies. Detected on  $\geq 2$  occasions 12 weeks apart. Clinical criteria: vascular thrombosis or pregnancy morbidity. Can be transient (infection, drugs) or persistent.

### Antiphospholipid Antibody

An autoantibody directed against phospholipid-binding proteins. Persistent antibodies may be associated with thrombosis or pregnancy complications, particularly in antiphospholipid syndrome.

### Antiphospholipid Syndrome

A systemic autoimmune thrombophilia characterized by arterial and venous thrombosis, pregnancy morbidity, and persistent antiphospholipid antibody positivity.

#### Synonyms:

APS (Antiphospholipid Syndrome)

### Antiplatelet Therapy

Treatment with medicines that reduce platelet activation or aggregation, such as aspirin or clopidogrel, when clinically indicated to reduce arterial clotting.

### Antipruritic

A medication that relieves itching (pruritus).

### Antipsychotic

A drug used to treat psychotic disorders (schizophrenia, schizoaffective disorder, psychosis in bipolar/manic states and delirium). Typical (first-generation): haloperidol, chlorpromazine—D2 blockade, high EPS/tardive dyskinesia risk, hyperprolactinemia.

### Antipsychotic-Induced Parkinsonism

Drug-induced bradykinesia, rigidity, tremor, or pos-

tural instability caused by dopamine-receptor blockade, usually from antipsychotic treatment. Management involves reviewing the medication, dose, alternatives, and symptomatic treatment when appropriate.

### Antipyretic

A drug that reduces fever by lowering the hypothalamic set point, typically by inhibiting prostaglandin synthesis in the preoptic hypothalamus. Acetaminophen and NSAIDs (ibuprofen, aspirin) are the principal antipyretics.

### Antiretroviral Therapy

Treatment of HIV infection with combinations of antiretroviral agents. ART targets multiple steps in the viral life cycle including entry, reverse transcription, integration, and maturation. Combination ART suppresses viral replication and restores immune function. ART is lifelong therapy.

### Antiseptic

Substances used on wounds to prevent or treat infection; they kill or slow the growth of disease-causing organisms, such as bacteria, on the surface of the body.

### Antisocial Personality Disorder

A pattern of disregard for and violation of the rights of others occurring since age 15 years. At least three of seven criteria: failure to conform to social norms, deceitfulness, impulsivity, irritability and aggressiveness, reckless disregard for safety, consistent irresponsibility, and lack of remorse.

#### Synonyms:

Disorder Antisocial Personality (Antisocial Personality Disorder) Personality Disorder, Antisocial Personality Disorder Antisocial (Antisocial Personality Disorder)

### Antispasmodic

A medication that reduces smooth muscle spasm, primarily in the gastrointestinal tract. Anticholinergic agents: hyoscyamine, dicyclomine, atropine — block muscarinic M3 receptors on GI smooth muscle, reducing contractions and peristalsis, used for



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irritable bowel syndrome and functional dyspepsia.

**Synonyms:**

Antispasmodics

**Antispasmodics**

Alternate index label; see *Antispasmodic*.

**Antistreptolysin O Titer**

A blood test that measures antibodies against streptolysin O, a toxin produced by group A streptococci. Rising or elevated titers support recent streptococcal infection and help evaluate suspected rheumatic fever or poststreptococcal glomerulonephritis, although a single value does not prove active infection.

**Antisynthetase Syndrome**

An autoimmune disorder associated with antibodies against aminoacyl-tRNA synthetases, especially anti-Jo-1. It may cause interstitial lung disease, inflammatory muscle disease, arthritis, fever, Raynaud phenomenon, or mechanic's hands.

**Antithrombin**

Natural anticoagulant. Inhibits thrombin, factor Xa. Deficiency causes thrombosis.

**Antithrombin Deficiency**

A rare (1 in 2,000-5,000), strongly thrombophilic inherited disorder (autosomal dominant). Antithrombin (previously antithrombin III) is a serine protease inhibitor that inactivates thrombin and factors Xa, IXa, XIa, and XIIa. Heterozygous: 10-50 fold increased VTE risk, more severe than factor V Leiden.

**Antithrombin III Deficiency**

An inherited or acquired thrombophilia caused by reduced antithrombin activity, leading to increased risk of venous thromboembolism.

**Antithyroid**

A medicine or treatment that reduces thyroid-hormone production or activity. Examples include thioamides, radioactive iodine, and medicines that reduce the effects of thyroid hormone; the choice

depends on the cause and clinical situation.

**Antitubercular Agents**

Antimicrobial drugs used to treat *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* infections.

**Antitussive**

A medication that suppresses the cough reflex, used for dry, non-productive cough.

**Antiviral**

A class of drugs that inhibit viral replication, used to treat viral infections.

**Antiviral Drug Classes**

Major classes of antiviral agents include nucleoside analogues (acyclovir, tenofovir), protease inhibitors (ritonavir, atazanavir), reverse transcriptase inhibitors (efavirenz, sofosbuvir), and neuraminidase inhibitors (oseltamivir). Each class targets a specific step in the viral replication cycle.

**Antrochoanal Polyp**

A benign, single nasal polyp originating from the maxillary sinus mucosa and extending through the accessory ostium into the choana and nasopharynx. It is most common in children and young adults, presenting with unilateral nasal obstruction and rhinorrhea. Treatment is endoscopic surgical removal.

**Anuria**

Near absence of urine production, often defined in adults as less than about 100 milliliters in 24 hours.

**Anus**

The terminal opening of the gastrointestinal tract through which feces are expelled. It is surrounded by the internal smooth-muscle sphincter and external skeletal-muscle sphincter.

**Anxiety**

A normal emotional response to perceived danger, but anxiety disorders involve excessive, persistent worry that interferes with daily life. Symptoms can include restlessness, rapid heart rate, muscle



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tension, and avoidance behaviors.

### **Anxiety Disorder**

A group of psychiatric conditions characterized by excessive fear, anxiety, and related behavioral disturbances. Includes generalized anxiety disorder (GAD), panic disorder, social anxiety disorder, specific phobias, and agoraphobia.

### **Anxiolytic**

A medicine or other treatment that reduces anxiety. Choice depends on the anxiety disorder, urgency, coexisting conditions, adverse effects, and patient preference; psychological therapies and, when appropriate, antidepressant medicines are commonly used for persistent anxiety.

### **Aorta**

Largest artery, from the left ventricle distributing oxygenated blood systemically. Approximately 30 cm long, 2.5 cm diameter. Four segments: ascending aorta, aortic arch (brachiocephalic trunk, left common carotid, left subclavian), descending thoracic aorta, descending abdominal aorta (bifurcating into common iliacs at L4).

### **Aortic Aneurysm**

A permanent, localized enlargement of the aorta caused by weakening of its wall. It may occur in the thoracic or abdominal aorta and can enlarge, dissect, or rupture; management depends on its site, size, growth, symptoms, and the patient's risk.

### **Aortic Aneurysm Rupture**

Full-thickness failure of an aortic aneurysm with bleeding into a body cavity or surrounding tissue. Ruptured aneurysm commonly causes sudden pain, shock, and collapse and requires immediate resuscitation and operative or endovascular repair.

### **Aortic Aneurysm Screening**

Evaluation of selected people for an aortic aneurysm before symptoms develop. Screening may use abdominal ultrasonography or other imaging according to the person's risk.

### **Aortic Arch**

Curves from second right sternocostal joint superiorly and left, then posteriorly and inferiorly to T4. From right to left: brachiocephalic trunk, left common carotid, left subclavian. Related to left recurrent laryngeal nerve (hooking under it), trachea, esophagus, left phrenic nerve. Arch aneurysms may cause hoarseness and SVC syndrome.

### **Aortic Coarctation**

Congenital narrowing of the aorta, usually near the insertion of the ductus arteriosus. It causes higher blood pressure and stronger pulses in the arms than in the legs, with a radio-femoral delay; severe neonatal disease may present with shock when the ductus closes.

### **Aortic Dissection**

A tear in the inner layer of the aorta that allows blood to enter the wall and form a false channel. Stanford type A involves the ascending aorta; type B does not. Treatment depends on the type, symptoms, complications, and overall clinical condition.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dissecting Aneurysm Dissection Aorta (Aortic Dissection)

### **Aortic Embolism**

Obstruction of a systemic artery by material originating in the aorta, such as thrombus or atheromatous debris, causing distal ischemia.

### **Aortic Graft Infection**

Infection involving a prosthetic or endovascular aortic graft, potentially causing sepsis, pseudoaneurysm, hemorrhage, or aortoenteric fistula. Management usually requires prolonged antimicrobial treatment and individualized surgical or endovascular source control.

### **Aortic Regurgitation**

Incomplete closure of the aortic valve allowing blood to flow backward from the aorta to the left ventricle during diastole. Causes include bicuspid aortic valve, endocarditis, aortic root dilation, hypertension, and connective tissue disorders. Murmur: early

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diastolic decrescendo murmur at the left sternal border.

### **Aortic Regurgitation Murmur**

Early diastolic decrescendo murmur heard best at the left sternal border with the patient sitting up and leaning forward in end-expiration. Wide pulse pressure, water-hammer pulses (Corrigan pulse), de Musset sign (head bobbing with each pulse), and Duroziez sign (femoral bruit with compression).

### **Aortic Stenosis**

Narrowing of the aortic valve opening, obstructing left ventricular outflow. It is the most common valvular disease in developed countries, usually caused by calcific degeneration. Symptoms include angina, syncope, and heart failure (SAD triad).

### **Aortic Stenosis Grading**

Severity grading: mild (valve area  $>1.5$  cm<sup>2</sup>, mean gradient  $<20$  mmHg), moderate (valve area 1.0-1.5 cm<sup>2</sup>, mean gradient 20-40 mmHg), severe (valve area  $<1.0$  cm<sup>2</sup>, mean gradient  $>40$  mmHg). Very severe (valve area  $<0.6$  cm<sup>2</sup>, mean gradient  $>60$  mmHg) indicates critical stenosis. Grading guides timing of intervention.

### **Aortic Valve**

A semilunar valve between the left ventricle and aorta, normally composed of right, left, and non-coronary cusps. It opens during systole and closes during diastole to direct blood flow. Each cusp forms a sinus of Valsalva from which coronary arteries originate. Opens during systole; closes during diastole.

### **Aortic Valve Disease**

Abnormal narrowing, leakage, or structural change of the valve between the left ventricle and aorta. It may cause chest pain, breathlessness, fatigue, fainting, or no symptoms initially. Evaluation commonly includes examination and echocardiography; severe disease may require specialist treatment.

### **Aortography**

Contrast imaging of aorta. Evaluates aneurysm, dis-

section, occlusion. Largely replaced by CTA/MRA.

### **APACHE II Score**

Severity scoring system for critically ill patients incorporating physiological variables, age, and chronic health status to generate scores from zero to seventy-one. Higher scores indicate greater severity and higher mortality. In acute pancreatitis, scores of eight or greater indicate severe disease.

### **APC Tumor Suppressor**

The adenomatous polyposis coli protein is a large multidomain tumor suppressor that functions as a critical negative regulator of the canonical Wnt signaling pathway.

### **Apert Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant craniosynostosis syndrome caused by FGFR2 mutations (most commonly Ser252Trp or Pro253Arg).

### **Aphasia**

Impairment of language comprehension or production resulting from brain damage, most commonly from stroke affecting the left hemisphere (dominant) language areas.

### **Apheresis**

A procedure that removes a selected blood component, such as plasma, platelets, or abnormal cells, and returns the remaining components to the patient or donor.

### **Aphonia**

Complete loss of the ability to phonate, distinct from dysphonia in which voice is present but abnormal. Causes are organic (bilateral vocal cord paralysis, severe laryngitis, laryngeal trauma, structural lesions) or psychogenic (conversion disorder, muscle tension dysphonia). Whispered speech and cough are usually preserved.

### **Aphthous Stomatitis**

Recurrent painful ulcers of the oral mucosa with a shallow base and erythematous border, commonly

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known as canker sores.

### **Aphthous Ulcer**

A recurrent, painful ulcer of the oral mucosa. See Canker Sore.

### **Apicoectomy**

Surgical removal of root tip and periapical lesion. Indication: failed root canal therapy.

### **Aplastic Anemia**

A bone marrow failure syndrome characterized by pancytopenia (anemia, leukopenia, thrombocytopenia) and a hypocellular bone marrow with replacement by fat cells, resulting from immune-mediated destruction of hematopoietic stem cells.

### **Apnea**

Temporary cessation of breathing. Clinically important apnea may cause low oxygen, carbon-dioxide retention, or bradycardia.

### **Apnea Of Prematurity**

Recurrent pauses in breathing in a premature infant, sometimes accompanied by bradycardia or oxygen desaturation. It may be central, obstructive, or mixed. Management includes monitoring and, when needed, respiratory stimulation or support.

### **Apnea-Hypopnea Index**

Number of apneas plus hypopneas per hour of sleep. Apnea = airflow cessation > 10 seconds. Hypopnea = partial obstruction with desaturation or arousal. AHI < 5 normal, 5–14 mild, 15–29 moderate, ≥ 30 severe.

### **Apneustic Breathing**

A breathing pattern characterized by a prolonged inspiratory pause, seen in brainstem lesions (particularly the pons). It indicates damage to the apneustic center and is a poor prognostic sign in neurological injury. It may require mechanical ventilation.

### **Apnoea**

Temporary cessation of breathing, defined as com-

plete cessation of airflow for at least 10 seconds. Obstructive apnea: airway collapse despite respiratory effort (common in obstructive sleep apnea).

### **Apoenzyme**

The protein component of an enzyme without its required cofactor or coenzyme. Inactive or minimally active until the cofactor binds. The complete, catalytically active complex of apoenzyme + cofactor is called the holoenzyme.

### **Apoptosis**

Programmed cell death. Dysregulated in cancer (avoiding death). Pro-apoptotic genes: BAX, P53. Anti-apoptotic: BCL-2.

### **Apoptosis Extrinsic Pathway**

The extrinsic pathway of apoptosis is triggered by extracellular ligands binding to death receptors belonging to the tumor necrosis factor receptor superfamily, including Fas (CD95), TNFR1, and TRAIL receptors DR4 and DR5.

### **Apoptosis Intrinsic Pathway**

The intrinsic, or mitochondrial, pathway of apoptosis is initiated by intracellular stress signals including DNA damage, growth factor withdrawal, endoplasmic reticulum stress, and hypoxia.

### **Apparent Mineralocorticoid Excess**

Rare autosomal recessive disorder caused by deficiency of 11-beta-hydroxysteroid dehydrogenase type 2 normally converting cortisol to cortisone in the collecting duct. Cortisol activates mineralocorticoid receptors causing severe hypertension, hypokalemia, metabolic alkalosis, and low renin with low aldosterone.

### **Appendectomy**

Surgical removal of the appendix, the most common emergency surgical procedure performed worldwide. Appendectomy is indicated for acute appendicitis, the most common surgical emergency with a lifetime risk of 7-8 percent and peak incidence between 10 and 30 years.

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## Appendiceal Tumors

Neoplasms arising in the appendix, including neuroendocrine tumors, mucinous neoplasms, and adenocarcinoma. Some are found incidentally, whereas others cause pain, obstruction, or abdominal distention. Evaluation and treatment depend on the tumor type, size, spread, and pathologic features.

## Appendicitis

Inflammation of the vermiform appendix, often caused by obstruction of its lumen. It may cause abdominal pain that moves to the right lower quadrant, nausea, loss of appetite, and fever; diagnosis and treatment depend on clinical assessment, laboratory tests, imaging, and complications.

### Synonyms:

Pain Lower Right Abdomen (Appendicitis)

## Appendix

A blind-ended tubular diverticulum of the cecum, typically 6-10 cm long, rich in lymphoid tissue. Its position is variable (retrocecal, pelvic, or retroileal); the base usually projects near McBurney's point, one-third of the distance from the anterior superior iliac spine to the umbilicus.

## Appetite Regulation

Complex control by hormones (leptin, ghrelin, insulin, CCK), neural signals, psychological factors. Leptin signals satiety, ghrelin signals hunger.

## Applied Behavior Analysis

A behavioral intervention based on learning principles that uses observation, measurement, and reinforcement to increase useful behaviors and reduce behaviors that interfere with functioning. It may be used in autism care and other settings, with goals individualized to the person.

## Apraxia

Inability to perform learned, skilled motor movements despite intact motor function, sensation, coordination, and comprehension.

## Aquagenic Keratoderma

Transient, painful whitish thickening and wrinkling of the palms and soles occurring within minutes of water immersion, accompanied by a prickling or burning sensation. It is often associated with cystic fibrosis or other sweat gland disorders but can also be idiopathic or drug-induced. Symptoms resolve shortly after drying the skin.

## Aquatic Therapy

Exercise or rehabilitation performed in water, using buoyancy and resistance to support movement and conditioning.

## Aqueous Humor

A clear, watery fluid that fills the anterior and posterior chambers of the eye, maintaining intraocular pressure and providing nutrients and oxygen to the avascular cornea and lens while removing metabolic waste products.

## Arachnoid Cyst

A congenital, benign, cerebrospinal fluid-filled cyst within the arachnoid membrane, most commonly found in the middle cranial fossa. Most are asymptomatic and discovered incidentally on imaging, but large cysts may cause headache, seizures, or focal neurological deficits.

## Arachnoid Mater

The middle of the three meninges, a delicate avascular membrane lying between the dura mater and pia mater. The subarachnoid space between arachnoid and pia contains cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) and major vessels. Arachnoid granulations (villi) project into the dural venous sinuses and mediate CSF resorption.

## ARB-Neprilysin Inhibitor

Sacubitril/valsartan combines an ARB with a neprilysin inhibitor, increasing natriuretic peptide levels while blocking the renin-angiotensin system. The PARADIGM-HF trial demonstrated superior reduction in cardiovascular death and heart failure hospitalization compared to enalapril.

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## Arbovirus

A virus transmitted by mosquitoes or other member of the arthropod phylum.

## ARBs

Block angiotensin II AT1 receptors providing renoprotection similar to ACE inhibitors. Alternative for ACE inhibitor cough. Do not combine ACE inhibitor and ARB due to increased adverse effects without benefit. Similar renoprotective effects to ACE inhibitors.

## Arcus Senilis (Corneal Arcus)

A white, gray, or bluish opaque ring in the peripheral corneal stroma separated from the limbus by a clear zone (lucid interval of Vogt). Caused by lipid (cholesterol) deposition in the peripheral cornea. Common and benign in elderly individuals (>60 years).

### Synonyms:

Corneal Arcus

## ARDS

Acute respiratory distress syndrome is a severe inflammatory lung injury causing acute oxygenation failure and bilateral lung opacities that are not fully explained by heart failure or fluid overload. Common causes include sepsis, pneumonia, trauma, and aspiration.

## Area Under The Concentration-Time Curve

The integral of a drug's plasma concentration over time. AUC estimates total systemic exposure and is used to compare bioavailability, guide dosing for selected medicines, and characterize pharmacokinetic interactions.

## Argininosuccinic Aciduria

Autosomal recessive urea cycle disorder caused by deficiency of argininosuccinate lyase (ASL gene, 7cen-q11.2). Biochemical hallmark: accumulation of argininosuccinic acid in blood, urine, and CSF with hyperammonemia, low citrulline, and elevated argininosuccinic acid.

## Argyll Robertson Pupil

A small, irregular pupil that constricts during near focusing but responds poorly or not at all to light. It is classically associated with neurosyphilis but can have other causes; the finding requires clinical evaluation.

## Armpit Lump

A lump or swelling in the axilla, commonly caused by an enlarged lymph node, skin infection, cyst, or benign growth. Persistent, hard, fixed, enlarging, or unexplained lumps require medical assessment.

## Arnold-Chiari Malformation

Herniation of cerebellar tonsils through the foramen magnum into the upper cervical spinal canal. Type II (myelomeningocele-associated) is the most common form in pediatrics. Associated with hydrocephalus, syringomyelia, and spinal cord dysfunction. Symptoms include headache, neck pain, and lower cranial nerve palsies.

## Aromatase Excess Syndrome

Rare autosomal dominant condition caused by mutations in the CYP19A1 gene leading to overexpression of aromatase enzyme and excessive estrogen production. Presents in males with gynecomastia, advanced bone age, and accelerated linear growth with early epiphyseal closure. In females with precocious puberty, macroclitoris, and virilization.

## Aromatase Inhibitor

A class of medications that inhibit aromatase, the enzyme that converts androgens (androstenedione, testosterone) to estrogens (estrone, estradiol) in peripheral tissues (adipose, breast, muscle, bone). Used primarily in hormone receptor-positive breast cancer in postmenopausal women.

## Arrector Pili Muscle

A small band of involuntary smooth muscle attached to a hair follicle and the superficial dermis. Sympathetic stimulation causes it to contract, pulling the hair upright and producing temporary piloerection, commonly called goosebumps. Contraction also compresses nearby sebaceous glands and may



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help release sebum onto the skin.

**Synonyms:**  
goosebumps.

### **Arrested Caries**

A carious lesion that is no longer progressing, often because the surface has become hard, smooth, and cleansable. Arrested lesions may be monitored and remineralized; treatment depends on activity, cavitation, cleansability, and patient risk.

### **Arrhythmia**

Any abnormality of cardiac rate, rhythm, or site of impulse origin, arising through enhanced automaticity, reentry, or triggered activity. Classified by rate as tachyarrhythmia or bradyarrhythmia and by site as supraventricular or ventricular. Diagnosis rests on the 12-lead ECG and ambulatory monitoring when intermittent.

### **Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Cardiomyopathy**

A genetic cardiomyopathy characterized by fibrofatty replacement of the right ventricular myocardium, predisposing to ventricular arrhythmias and sudden cardiac death, particularly during exercise. ECG shows T-wave inversions in V1-V3 and epsilon waves; diagnosis uses echocardiography, cardiac MRI, and genetic testing.

### **Arsenic Toxicity**

Systemic poisoning from arsenic exposure causing gastrointestinal distress, cardiac arrhythmias, peripheral neuropathy, and characteristic Mees lines on nails, requiring chelation therapy with dimercaprol or succimer.

### **Art Therapy**

Use of art-making for therapeutic purposes. Emotional expression, coping, self-awareness.

### **Arterial Blood Gas**

Measurement of arterial pH, carbon-dioxide tension, oxygen tension, bicarbonate, and related acid-base variables. It helps assess ventilation, oxygenation, and metabolic or respiratory acid-base disorders.

### **Arterial Blood Gas Analyzer**

An analyzer that measures arterial pH, partial pressures of oxygen and carbon dioxide, and usually bicarbonate or calculated acid-base variables. It is used to assess ventilation, oxygenation, and metabolic or respiratory acid-base disorders.

### **Arterial Catheter**

A catheter placed in an artery, commonly the radial artery, for continuous blood-pressure monitoring and repeated arterial blood sampling. Complications include hemorrhage, thrombosis, infection, and distal ischemia.

### **Arterial Catheterization**

Placement of a catheter in an artery, usually the radial artery, for continuous blood-pressure measurement and repeated arterial blood sampling. It is used when rapid hemodynamic or gas-exchange assessment is clinically necessary and carries risks including bleeding, infection, thrombosis, and ischemia.

### **Arterial Duplex**

Ultrasound technique combining B-mode imaging and Doppler flow assessment. Used for evaluating arterial stenosis, aneurysm, graft patency. Non-invasive, widely available.

### **Arterial Insufficiency**

Reduced arterial blood flow to a tissue or limb, causing ischemic symptoms such as claudication, rest pain, cool skin, delayed capillary refill, and diminished pulses. Most commonly caused by atherosclerosis; assessed by ankle-brachial index and duplex ultrasound.

### **Arterial Line**

A catheter inserted into a peripheral artery (most commonly radial, also femoral, brachial, dorsalis pedis) for continuous blood pressure monitoring and arterial blood gas sampling. Allen test: assesses ulnar collateral flow before radial artery cannulation.

### **Arterial Ulcer**

A chronic wound caused by arterial insufficiency



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(peripheral artery disease). Located on distal extremities: toes, heels, lateral malleolus, and sites of pressure. Presents with punched-out, deep, well-demarcated wound with pale or necrotic base, minimal exudate, and cool, hairless, shiny skin.

### **Arteriole**

A small artery that delivers blood to a capillary bed. Arteriolar smooth muscle regulates vascular resistance and controls tissue perfusion and systemic blood pressure.

### **Arteriosclerosis**

Chronic inflammatory disease of medium and large arteries characterized by accumulation of lipids, inflammatory cells, and fibrous tissue within the arterial wall, forming atherosclerotic plaques. See Atherosclerosis.

### **Arteriovenous Fistula**

A surgically created connection between an artery and a vein, usually for hemodialysis. The increased blood flow enlarges and strengthens the vein for repeated access. The site and time needed for maturation depend on the patient's vessels and clinical circumstances.

### **Arteriovenous Graft**

Synthetic conduit connecting artery to vein for dialysis. Used when veins inadequate for fistula. Thrombosis and infection more common than AVF. Can be used earlier than fistula. Dec clotting with thrombectomy or angioplasty.

### **Arteriovenous Malformation**

Abnormal connection between artery and vein without capillary bed. Can bleed or cause symptoms.

### **Arthralgia**

Pain in one or more joints without objective evidence of joint inflammation such as swelling, warmth, or structural damage. Common causes include viral infections, overuse, autoimmune disease, and early degenerative change; persistent, severe, or multifocal pain warrants clinical evaluation.

### **Artery**

A blood vessel that carries oxygenated blood away from the heart to the tissues, except for the pulmonary arteries which carry deoxygenated blood to the lungs. Arteries have thick, elastic, muscular walls that withstand high pressure and distribute blood throughout the body. The aorta is the largest artery.

### **Arthritis**

Inflammation of one or more joints, characterized by joint pain, swelling, warmth, and stiffness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Joint Inflammation (Arthritis)

### **Arthrocentesis**

Aspiration of joint fluid for diagnostic or therapeutic purposes. Indications: septic arthritis (urgent, crystals), inflammatory arthritis (gout, pseudogout), hemorrhagic effusion (trauma, coagulopathy), and therapeutic drainage for symptomatic relief.

### **Arthrodesis**

Surgical fusion of a joint by removing or preparing articular surfaces and stabilizing the bones until osseous union occurs. It relieves pain and provides stability at the cost of joint motion.

### **Arthrography**

Contrast injected into joint for imaging. Used for shoulder, knee, hip evaluation. MR arthrography more common now.

### **Arthrogryposis**

A group of congenital disorders characterized by multiple joint contractures present at birth, caused by decreased fetal movement (fetal akinesia) during development.

### **Arthroplasty**

Surgical reconstruction or replacement of a joint to relieve pain, restore alignment, or improve function. It may be partial or total and is commonly performed for advanced degenerative joint disease, fracture, inflammatory arthritis, or other destruc-

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tive joint conditions.

### **Arthroscopy**

Minimally invasive joint visualization and intervention via a rigid arthroscope inserted through small portals, used for meniscal and ligamentous repair, chondroplasty, loose body removal, and synovectomy.

### **Articular Cartilage Injuries**

Chondral/osteochondral lesions: Outerbridge grading (I: softening, II: fibrillation <50%, III: fibrillation >50%, IV: subchondral bone exposed). OCD (osteochondritis dissecans): subchondral bone necrosis, fragment separation (knee: lateral femoral condyle, elbow: capitellum, ankle: talar dome).

### **Artifacts**

Image distortions not representing true anatomy. Types: motion, beam hardening, metal, aliasing, partial volume. Recognition important for accurate interpretation.

### **Artificial Pacemaker**

An implanted device that delivers electrical impulses to maintain an appropriate heart rate when the heart's natural conduction system is inadequate.

### **Artificial Rupture Of Membranes**

The intentional rupture of the amniotic sac with a small hook-like instrument (Amnihook) during a cervical exam to induce or augment labor. Indications: induction or augmentation of labor, placement of internal monitors (fetal scalp electrode, intrauterine pressure catheter), and assessment of amniotic fluid (meconium staining).

### **Artificial Ventricle (Total Artificial Heart)**

A pulsatile, pneumatically or electrically driven biventricular replacement that removes the native ventricles. Indications: end-stage heart failure bridging to transplant or destination therapy. Requirements: surgical implantation, external power source, anticoagulation.

**Synonyms:**

Total Artificial Heart

### **Arytenoid Cartilage**

The arytenoid cartilages are a pair of small, pyramid-shaped cartilages located on the posterior aspect of the larynx, articulating with the superior border of the cricoid cartilage lamina, and they serve as the attachment points for the vocal cords and the intrinsic laryngeal muscles that control vocal cord movement.

### **ASA Physical Status Classification System**

A system developed by the American Society of Anesthesiologists to assess and communicate a patient's pre-operative physical status and comorbidities. It ranges from ASA I (a normal healthy patient) to ASA VI (a declared brain-dead patient whose organs are being removed for donor purposes).

### **Asbestosis**

Diffuse pulmonary fibrosis caused by prolonged inhalation of asbestos fibers. It may cause progressive shortness of breath and increases the risk of lung cancer and mesothelioma.

### **Ascariasis**

Infection with the soil-transmitted roundworm *Ascaris lumbricoides*.

### **Ascending Aorta**

From left ventricle at the aortic valve to the sternal angle (approximately 5 cm), enclosed in pericardium. Gives rise to right/left coronary arteries at the aortic sinuses. Most common site of aneurysm and dissection, especially in Marfan syndrome, bicuspid aortic valve, and hypertension.

### **Ascending Aortic Aneurysm**

Abnormal enlargement of the ascending portion of the aorta. It may be associated with a bicuspid aortic valve, connective-tissue disease, hypertension, or atherosclerosis.

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## Ascending Colon

Extends from cecum to hepatic flexure below the liver, approximately 15-20 cm, retroperitoneal (fixed to posterior abdominal wall). Anteriorly: abdominal wall. Posteriorly: right kidney. Absorbs water/electrolytes and compacts fecal matter. Tumors may present as a palpable right-sided mass.

## Ascites

Pathological accumulation of fluid within the peritoneal cavity representing the most common decompensating event in cirrhosis. The pathogenesis involves splanchnic arterial vasodilation reducing effective arterial blood volume and activating neurohormonal mechanisms leading to sodium and water retention.

## Aseptic Loosening

Loss of fixation of an implant without active infection, commonly caused by mechanical stress and a biologic response to wear particles. It may cause pain, radiographic lucency, instability, and need for revision surgery.

## Aseptic Technique

A set of laboratory practices preventing contamination of sterile sites, cultures, and specimens by unwanted microorganisms. Key elements include hand hygiene, sterile fields and instruments, surface disinfection, and minimal exposure of sterile items to air and touch, forming the basis of reliable clinical and culture work.

## Asherman Syndrome

Intrauterine adhesions or scar tissue that partially or completely obliterate the uterine cavity, most often after uterine instrumentation or pregnancy-related curettage. It may cause hypomenorrhea or amenorrhea, infertility, recurrent miscarriage, or abnormal placentation.

## Asperger Syndrome

A former diagnostic term for a neurodevelopmental condition characterized by persistent social-communication difficulties and restricted or repetitive interests or behaviors, without the intellec-

tual or language impairment traditionally associated with classic autism. Current diagnostic systems generally classify it within autism spectrum disorder; support is individualized.

### Synonyms:

Disorder Asperger (Asperger Syndrome) Syndrome Asperger (Asperger Syndrome)

## Aspergillosis

A spectrum of diseases caused by the fungus *Aspergillus* (most commonly *A. fumigatus*). Allergic forms: allergic bronchopulmonary aspergillosis (ABPA, in asthma or cystic fibrosis – wheezing, eosinophilia, pulmonary infiltrates), allergic *Aspergillus* sinusitis.

### Synonyms:

*Aspergillus* Infection (Aspergillosis)

## Asphyxia

A life-threatening lack of oxygen due to drowning, choking, or an obstruction of the airways. Management: remove obstruction, rescue breathing, CPR if needed. Foreign body airway obstruction: Heimlich maneuver (abdominal thrusts) for conscious adults; back blows and chest thrusts for infants.

## Aspiration

The inhalation of foreign material (oropharyngeal secretions, gastric contents, food, liquid, or blood) into the larynx and lower respiratory tract. Aspiration pneumonia (Mendelson syndrome) is a chemical lung injury caused by acidic gastric fluid.

## Aspiration Pneumonia

Infectious pneumonia from aspiration of oropharyngeal secretions. Risk factors: dysphagia, impaired consciousness, enteral feeding. Common pathogens: anaerobes, gram-negative bacilli. Treatment: antibiotics covering oral flora.

## Aspiration Pneumonitis

Chemical lung injury caused by inhalation of gastric contents, characterized by bronchospasm, hypoxemia, pulmonary edema, and atelectasis. Risk factors include full stomach, emergency surgery, obesity, pregnancy, gastroesophageal reflux, bowel ob-

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struction, and decreased consciousness.

### **Aspiration Risk**

The likelihood that food, liquid, saliva, or gastric contents will enter the larynx or lower respiratory tract. Risk rises with dysphagia, delirium, stroke, neuromuscular disease, reflux, poor dentition, and reduced consciousness; assessment and prevention are multidisciplinary.

### **Acetylsalicylic Acid**

The chemical name for aspirin, a salicylate drug with analgesic, antipyretic, anti-inflammatory, and antiplatelet effects.

### **Acrochordon**

A benign, soft, flesh-colored skin tag, usually occurring in skin folds such as the neck, axilla, or groin.

### **Advanced Cardiac Life Support**

A structured set of interventions for cardiac arrest and other life-threatening cardiovascular emergencies, including high-quality CPR, rhythm recognition, defibrillation, airway management, and medications.

### **Allen Test**

A bedside test of collateral blood flow to the hand through the radial and ulnar arteries, commonly performed before radial-artery puncture or cannulation.

### **Anatomic Snuffbox**

A triangular depression on the lateral wrist that becomes visible when the thumb is extended. Tenderness there may suggest a scaphoid fracture.

### **Ankle-Foot Orthosis**

A brace that supports the ankle and foot and helps control alignment, stability, or foot drop.

### **Aspirin (Salicylate) Toxicity**

Mixed respiratory alkalosis and metabolic acidosis. Early: tinnitus, hyperventilation, respiratory alkalo-

sis. Late: metabolic acidosis, fever, seizures, coma. Treatment: activated charcoal, urine alkalization (sodium bicarbonate), hemodialysis if severe (renal failure, pulmonary edema, severe acidosis, very high levels).

### **Synonyms:**

Salicylate

### **Aspirin-Exacerbated Respiratory Disease**

A triad of asthma, nasal polyps, and aspirin sensitivity due to COX-1 inhibition. It involves overproduction of cysteinyl leukotrienes. Leukotriene receptor antagonists are specifically effective.

### **Assist-Control Ventilation**

Ventilator delivers a set tidal volume at a set rate. Every breath receives the full set volume. Guarantees minimum rate and minute ventilation. Risk of respiratory alkalosis and auto-PEEP.

### **Assisted Breech Delivery**

Vaginal breech delivery with operator assistance after spontaneous delivery to the umbilicus.

### **Assisted Living**

Residential setting with assistance for ADLs. Less intensive than nursing home.

### **Assisted Reproductive Technology**

ART: fertility treatments involving manipulation of oocytes/sperm/embryos: in vitro fertilization (IVF), intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI), intrauterine insemination (IUI, some definitions), embryo cryopreservation, gamete donation, and surrogacy.

### **Assistive Device**

Equipment that helps a person perform activities, move safely, communicate, or maintain independence.

### **Assistive Device Training**

Instruction in selecting, fitting, using, and maintaining devices such as walkers, canes, or crutches, including safe walking and stair techniques.

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## Association Study

Comparison of allele frequencies between cases and controls. Genome-wide association studies (GWAS) identify common variants with small effects on complex diseases.

## Astereognosis

Inability to identify an object by touch alone despite intact primary somatosensory modalities (touch, vibration, proprioception), indicating dysfunction of the contralateral parietal association cortex (typically the postcentral gyrus region or the dominant inferior parietal lobule).

## Asterixis

Brief, irregular, non-rhythmic lapse of sustained posture causing a flapping movement, best elicited by asking the patient to hold the arms extended with wrists dorsiflexed ("hold arms up") for 30 seconds.

## Asthenopia

Eye strain or visual fatigue, often experienced as aching, burning, blurred vision, headache, or difficulty focusing after prolonged visual tasks. Refractive errors, dry eye, poor lighting, and extended screen use may contribute.

## Asthma

A chronic inflammatory disorder of the airways characterized by recurrent episodes of wheezing, breathlessness, chest tightness, and cough. Airflow limitation is often reversible. It involves eosinophilic inflammation, mucus hypersecretion, and smooth muscle hypertrophy.

## Asthma Exacerbation

An acute or subacute worsening of asthma symptoms and airflow limitation, typically causing increased wheeze, cough, chest tightness, or breathlessness.

## Asthma-COPD Overlap

Features of both asthma and COPD in the same patient. Characterized by persistent airflow limitation with features of both diseases: airway inflammation (eosinophilic and neutrophilic), bronchial hyperre-

sponsiveness, and partially reversible obstruction. Treatment: inhaled corticosteroids plus long-acting bronchodilators.

## Astigmatism

A refractive error caused by an irregular curvature of the cornea or lens, resulting in light rays being focused at multiple points rather than a single point on the retina, leading to blurred or distorted vision at all distances.

## Astrocytoma

A glioma arising from star-shaped cells called astrocytes. Graded I-IV by the WHO; grade IV (glioblastoma) is the most aggressive and common primary malignant brain tumor in adults.

## Asymptomatic Bacteriuria In Pregnancy

The presence of significant bacterial growth in a pregnant person's urine without urinary symptoms. It is identified by urine culture and is treated because it increases the risk of symptomatic urinary infection and kidney infection during pregnancy.

## Asystole

Complete cessation of cardiac electrical activity, presenting as a flat line on the ECG with no QRS complexes, P waves, or other organized electrical activity.

## Ataxia

Lack of voluntary coordination of muscle movements, resulting from dysfunction of the cerebellum, posterior columns, or peripheral nerves. Types: cerebellar (gait and limb ataxia, dysarthria, nystagmus), sensory (impaired proprioception causing sensory ataxia, positive Romberg sign), and vestibular (vertigo, nystagmus, nausea).

## Ataxia-Telangiectasia

An autosomal-recessive disorder usually caused by biallelic ATM variants, characterized by progressive ataxia, telangiectasias, immune deficiency, and increased cancer risk.

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### Ataxic Breathing

An irregular, unpredictable breathing pattern with random variations in rate and depth, seen in medullary lesions. It is the most dangerous respiratory pattern and often precedes respiratory arrest. It requires mechanical ventilation.

### Atelectasis

Complete or partial collapse of lung tissue, resulting in loss of aeration. It may be caused by airway obstruction (resorption atelectasis), pleural disease (compressive atelectasis), surfactant dysfunction (dissolution atelectasis), or scarring (cicatrization atelectasis). It impairs gas exchange and may predispose to infection.

#### Synonyms:

Lung Collapse

### Atherectomy

Mechanical removal of atherosclerotic plaque. Types: directional, laser, rotational, orbital. Used for peripheral arterial disease.

### Atherectomy (Vascular)

Removal or modification of atherosclerotic plaque from inside a blood vessel, usually with a catheter-based device.

#### Synonyms:

Vascular

### Atheroembolic Renal Disease

Cholesterol crystal embolization to kidneys after vascular procedures. AKI with livedo reticularis and peripheral eosinophilia. Renal biopsy shows cholesterol clefts. Poor prognosis with progressive renal failure.

### Atherosclerosis

Chronic inflammatory disease of medium and large arteries characterized by accumulation of lipids, inflammatory cells, and fibrous tissue within the arterial wall, forming atherosclerotic plaques. Initiating event is endothelial dysfunction from risk factors (hypertension, smoking, diabetes, dyslipidemia).

### Atherosclerotic Plaque

An atherosclerotic plaque is a lesion within the arterial intima composed of a necrotic lipid core covered by a fibrous cap, representing the pathological substrate of atherosclerotic cardiovascular disease.

### Athetosis

Slow, involuntary, writhing, sinuous movements predominantly of the distal extremities, sometimes also affecting the face, neck, and trunk, arising from dysfunction of the basal ganglia (putamen and globus pallidus).

### Athlete Foot

Tinea pedis: dermatophyte infection (*Trichophyton rubrum*, *T. mentagrophytes*) of the feet, common in those who wear occlusive footwear or use communal showers. Forms: interdigital (scaly, fissured, macerated between toes—most common), moccasin (diffuse plantar scaling), vesicular.

### Athlete's Foot

A superficial fungal infection of the feet, usually affecting the spaces between the toes and causing itching, scaling, maceration, or fissures. It is also called tinea pedis.

#### Synonyms:

tinea. Athletes Foot (Athlete's Foot) Ringworm Of The Foot Tinea Pedis (Athlete's Foot)

### Atlanto-Occipital Dislocation

Traumatic separation of the atlas from the occipital condyles, a highly unstable injury with high mortality often associated with spinal cord injury and requiring emergent immobilization.

### Atlas

First cervical vertebra articulating with occipital condyles at the atlanto-occipital joint for nodding movement. Lacks a body and spinous process; has anterior/posterior arches and lateral masses. Transverse foramina transmit vertebral arteries. The anterior arch has a facet for the axis dens.



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## Atopic Dermatitis

A chronic, relapsing inflammatory skin disease characterized by pruritus, xerosis, and eczematous lesions. It reflects epidermal-barrier dysfunction and immune dysregulation, with flares triggered by irritants, allergens, infection, stress, or climate.

### Synonyms:

Allergy Eczema (Atopic Dermatitis)

## Atopic Eruption Of Pregnancy

Pruritic eczematous skin eruptions occurring in pregnancy, presenting as eczematous patches or pruritic urticarial papules and plaques, typically resolving after delivery.

## Atopy

The genetic predisposition to develop immediate (IgE-mediated, type I) hypersensitivity reactions to common environmental allergens (pollen, dust mites, foods, pet dander).

## Atovaquone–Proguanil

An antimalarial combination used for prevention and treatment of *Plasmodium falciparum* malaria and selected travel-related malaria regimens.

## ATP (Adenosine Triphosphate)

The primary energy currency of the cell, composed of adenine, ribose, and three phosphate groups. Hydrolysis of the terminal phosphoanhydride bond releases  $\Delta G^\circ = -30.5 \text{ kJ/mol}$  ( $-7.3 \text{ kcal/mol}$ ), driving endergonic cellular processes such as muscle contraction, active transport, and biosynthesis.

### Synonyms:

Adenosine Triphosphate

## ATP Synthase

Complex V of electron transport chain. Uses proton gradient to synthesize ATP. Rotational catalysis mechanism.

## Atransferrinemia

Very rare autosomal recessive disorder of iron transport caused by mutations in the TF gene (3q22.1) leading to absence or severe deficiency of transferrin.

## Atrial Fibrillation

The most common sustained cardiac arrhythmia, characterized by rapid, disorganized atrial activity with an irregular ventricular response. ECG typically shows absent organized P waves and irregularly irregular RR intervals. Associated conditions include hypertension, ischemic or valvular heart disease, cardiomyopathy, atrial septal defect, and thyroid dysfunction, especially hyperthyroidism. Alcohol, myocarditis, pericarditis, pulmonary embolism, pneumonia, and cardiac surgery can precipitate AF; sick sinus syndrome may coexist as tachycardia-bradycardia syndrome. Some cases have no identified cause (formerly called lone atrial fibrillation).

### Synonyms:

AF (Atrial Fibrillation) Afib (Atrial Fibrillation)

## Atrial Fibrillation Ablation

A catheter-based procedure that creates lesions, usually around the pulmonary veins, to reduce the electrical triggers of atrial fibrillation. It may be considered for symptomatic patients when medicines are ineffective, not tolerated, or not preferred. Results and the need for repeat treatment vary with the type of atrial fibrillation and the person's clinical features.

## Atrial Flutter

A rapid, regular atrial rhythm (typically 250-350 bpm) caused by a macro-reentrant circuit, most commonly in the right atrium. ECG shows sawtooth flutter waves best seen in leads II, III, and aVF, with regular or irregular ventricular response depending on AV conduction ratio (commonly 2:1 or 4:1).

## Atrial Natriuretic Peptide

A peptide hormone secreted by atrial myocytes in response to atrial stretch from volume expansion. ANP promotes natriuresis and diuresis by increasing glomerular filtration rate, inhibiting sodium reabsorption in the collecting ducts, and reducing renin and aldosterone secretion.

## Atrial Septal Defect

Congenital opening in the interatrial septum allowing left-to-right shunting of blood. Small defects

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may close spontaneously. Larger defects cause right heart volume overload, right atrial and ventricular dilation, pulmonary hypertension, and eventually right heart failure. Paradoxical embolism may occur with right-to-left shunting.

### **Atrial Tachycardia**

Supraventricular tachycardia arising from an atrial focus outside the sinus node, often focal with rates 100-250 beats per minute with discrete P waves of different morphology from sinus P waves.

### **Atrioventricular Node**

Located in the posterior-inferior region of the interatrial septum near the coronary sinus. It receives impulses from the SA node via internodal pathways and delays them by approximately 120-200 milliseconds before transmitting them to the ventricles. This delay allows atrial contraction to complete before ventricular contraction.

### **Atrium**

One of the two upper chambers of the heart that receive blood returning to the heart. The right atrium receives deoxygenated blood from the superior and inferior venae cavae and the coronary sinus; the left atrium receives oxygenated blood from the four pulmonary veins.

### **Atropine In Organophosphate Poisoning**

A muscarinic antagonist used to reverse bronchospasm, bradycardia, and other muscarinic effects of organophosphate toxicity. Treatment is titrated to drying of respiratory secretions and improvement in ventilation, not to pupil size alone.

### **Attachment (Dental)**

Retentive device connecting denture to implant or tooth. Precision attachments preferred over bar attachments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Attack Rate**

The proportion of an at-risk population that de-

velops a specified illness during a defined outbreak or exposure period. It is a cumulative incidence measure commonly used for foodborne and other localized outbreaks.

### **Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder**

A neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by persistent patterns of inattention, hyperactivity, and impulsivity that interfere with functioning or development. Three presentations: predominantly inattentive, predominantly hyperactive-impulsive, and combined.

### **Attenuation Correction**

Compensation for photon absorption in tissue. CT-based (PET/CT), transmission source (SPECT), or MR-based (PET/MRI).

### **Attributable Risk**

Difference in risk between exposed and unexposed.  $AR = \text{incidence exposed} - \text{incidence unexposed}$ .

### **Atypia**

Cytologic or architectural abnormality that deviates from the expected appearance of a cell or tissue. Atypia may be reactive, degenerative, premalignant, or malignant and must be interpreted with architecture, clinical context, and ancillary studies.

### **Atypical Antipsychotics**

A class of modern psychiatric medications used to treat schizophrenia and bipolar disorder. They work by balancing dopamine and serotonin levels in the brain, which helps reduce symptoms like hallucinations and delusions with fewer movement-related side effects than older antipsychotics.

### **Atypical Facial Pain**

Chronic facial pain without identifiable cause. Psychological factors may contribute.

### **Atypical Features**

A specifier for depressive episodes characterized by mood reactivity, significant weight gain or increased appetite, hypersomnia, leaden paralysis, and a long-

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standing pattern of interpersonal rejection sensitivity. Atypical depression often presents in younger patients and may respond preferentially to MAOIs or SSRIs rather than TCAs.

### **Atypical Pneumonia**

Pneumonia with a gradual onset, relatively mild chest findings, and prominent systemic or extrapulmonary symptoms. Common causes include *Mycoplasma pneumoniae*, *Chlamydia pneumoniae*, and respiratory viruses.

### **Audiogram**

A chart that shows a person's ability to hear at different pitches or frequencies.

### **Audiologist**

A health professional who assesses hearing and fits hearing aids.

### **Audiometry**

Measurement of hearing sensitivity at different sound frequencies and intensities, usually using headphones or insert earphones.

### **Aural Fullness**

A sensation of pressure, blockage, or plugged feeling in the ear. Causes include eustachian-tube dysfunction, middle-ear fluid, cerumen impaction, inner-ear disorders, and temporomandibular-joint disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ear pressure; plugged-ear sensation; blocked-ear sensation.

### **Auer Rods**

Rod-shaped inclusions formed from fused azurophilic granules in myeloid precursor cells. They strongly support a myeloid neoplasm, especially acute myeloid leukemia, but diagnosis requires immunophenotyping, genetic studies, and clinical correlation.

### **Auger Electrons**

Low-energy electrons emitted during electron capture decay. Short range (nanometers), high linear

energy transfer. Potential for targeted radiotherapy if localized near DNA.

### **Augmentation Of Labor**

The stimulation of spontaneous contractions that are judged to be inadequate to achieve progressive cervical dilatation. Most commonly uses oxytocin (Pitocin) infusion. Also includes artificial rupture of membranes (AROM, amniotomy).

### **Auricle**

The visible external portion of the ear that projects from the side of the head, designed to collect and channel sound waves into the ear canal.

### **Auricular Hematoma**

A collection of blood between the cartilage of the external ear and its perichondrium, usually after blunt trauma. Without prompt drainage and compression, it may cause cartilage necrosis and permanent cauliflower-ear deformity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pinna hematoma; subperichondrial auricular hematoma.

### **Auscultation**

The act of listening to sounds produced within the body, typically using a stethoscope. Essential for assessing heart sounds, lung sounds, bowel sounds, and vascular bruits. Normal findings: S1 and S2 heart sounds, vesicular breath sounds, normal bowel sounds. Abnormal: murmurs, crackles, wheezes, rubs, bruits.

### **Auscultatory Gap**

A transient silence between the first and second sounds of blood pressure measurement, sometimes heard in hypertensive patients. Can lead to underestimation of systolic pressure if not recognized.

### **Austin Flint Murmur**

A mid-diastolic, low-pitched rumbling murmur heard at the apex, caused by the regurgitant jet from severe aortic regurgitation striking the anterior mitral leaflet.

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## Autism Spectrum Disorder

Neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by persistent deficits in social communication and social interaction across multiple contexts, restricted and repetitive patterns of behavior, interests, or activities. Symptoms present in early developmental period and cause clinically significant impairment.

## Autoantibody

An immunoglobulin that recognizes and binds an endogenous antigen. Autoantibodies may be pathogenic, as in autoimmune hemolytic anemia, or may serve as laboratory markers of autoimmune disease.

## Autoclave

Sterilization device using high-pressure steam. Parameters: 121°C, 15 psi, 15-30 minutes. Essential for infection control.

## Autogenic Drainage

A breathing technique using controlled breathing at different lung volumes to mobilize secretions from peripheral to central airways. It involves breathing at low lung volumes (collect), mid lung volumes (loosen), and high lung volumes (evacuate). It requires patient training and cooperation.

## Autograft

Tissue transplanted from one site to another within the same individual. Autografts are genetically identical to the recipient and generally avoid alloimmune rejection, although donor-site morbidity may occur.

## Autoimmune Disease

Autoimmune diseases result from loss of immunological self-tolerance, leading to immune-mediated attack on the body's own tissues.

## Autoimmune Disorder

A disease caused by an abnormal immune response against the body's own cells, tissues, or organs. Autoimmune disorders may be organ-specific or systemic and can produce inflammation, tissue injury, functional impairment, or circulating autoantibodies.

## Autoimmune Enteropathy

Rare immune-mediated disease causing persistent diarrhoea and small-intestinal mucosal injury, usually with villous atrophy and crypt hyperplasia. It may occur in children or adults and can be associated with other autoimmune disorders or immune dysregulation.

## Autoimmune Gastritis

Chronic atrophic gastritis caused by antibodies against parietal cells leading to achlorhydria and vitamin B12 deficiency. Associated with pernicious anemia and increased risk of gastric carcinoid tumors and type 1 gastric neuroendocrine tumors. Anti-parietal cell antibodies are present in approximately ninety percent of patients.

## Autoimmune Hemolytic Anemia

AIHA: hemolytic anemia due to antibodies directed against red blood cells. Warm AIHA (IgG, 37°C—idiopathic, SLE, CLL, drugs: methyl dopa, penicillin): splenic sequestration, spherocytes, positive direct antiglobulin (DAT).

## Autoimmune Hepatitis

Chronic hepatitis caused by immune-mediated destruction of hepatocytes characterized by interface hepatitis with lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate, elevated transaminases, hypergammaglobulinemia, and autoantibodies.

## Autoimmune Keratitis

Corneal inflammation associated with an immune-mediated disorder, sometimes occurring with rheumatoid arthritis, lupus, or granulomatosis with polyangiitis. It may cause pain, redness, corneal opacity, and reduced vision and requires urgent ophthalmic assessment. Treatment is directed at the cause and may include anti-inflammatory or immunosuppressive therapy.

## Autoimmune Pancreatitis

Chronic inflammatory condition characterized by dense lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate with IgG4-positive plasma cells representing the pancreatic manifestation of IgG4-related disease. Type 1 is

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more common affecting older men with elevated serum IgG4 and extrapancreatic involvement.

### **Autoimmune Polyendocrine Syndromes**

APS-1 (APECED, AIRE mutation): autosomal recessive, chronic mucocutaneous candidiasis, hypoparathyroidism, adrenal insufficiency (Addison's), plus type 1 diabetes, autoimmune thyroiditis, vitiligo, alopecia, pernicious anemia, hepatitis, asplenia.

### **Autoimmunity: Mechanisms**

Loss of tolerance: central (thymic negative selection defects, AIRE mutation → APS-1) and peripheral (Treg dysfunction, anergy failure, ignorance loss). Molecular mimicry: cross-reactivity between pathogen and self (rheumatic fever: Strep M protein + cardiac myosin; Guillain-Barre: Campylobacter + GM1 ganglioside; reactive arthritis).

### **Autologous Blood Donation**

Autologous blood donation involves preoperative collection and storage of the patient's own blood for intraoperative or postoperative transfusion. It eliminates risks of alloimmune reactions, transfusion-transmitted infections, and immune modulation.

### **Autonomic Dysreflexia**

Acute, potentially life-threatening sympathetic discharge in a person with spinal-cord injury at or above approximately T6, triggered by a noxious stimulus below the lesion. It causes sudden hypertension, headache, flushing or sweating above the lesion, and reflex bradycardia or other heart-rate changes.

### **Autonomic Nervous System**

The part of the peripheral nervous system that regulates involuntary functions, including heart rate, vascular tone, digestion, sweating, pupil size, and bladder activity.

### **Autonomic Neuropathy**

Damage to nerves that control involuntary functions such as heart rate, blood pressure, digestion, sweating, bladder function, and sexual function. Diabetes

is a common cause, but other diseases, toxins, and medicines may contribute. Symptoms depend on the affected organs and require evaluation of the underlying cause.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neuropathy, Autonomic

### **Autophagy**

Cellular self-degradation process delivering cytoplasmic components to lysosomes for recycling. Macroautophagy: phagophore forms, expands to autophagosome (LC3-II on membrane), fuses with lysosome (autolysosome) for degradation. Selective autophagy: mitophagy (damaged mitochondria), xenophagy (pathogens), and aggrephagy (protein aggregates).

### **Autopsy**

A postmortem examination of a body to determine cause and manner of death, performed by a forensic pathologist (medical examiner/coroner) or, for hospital autopsies, a pathologist.

### **Autopsy (Medicolegal)**

Systematic external examination and surgical dissection of a deceased body performed under legal authority by a forensic pathologist to determine the Cause, Manner, and Mechanism of Death, document injuries, collect evidence, and assist judicial investigations.

#### **Synonyms:**

Medicolegal

### **Autopsy (Post-Mortem Examination)**

Specialized surgical procedure performed on a deceased body to determine the cause of death, mechanism of death, manner of death (natural, accidental, suicide, homicide, or undetermined), state of health prior to death, and to document injuries or disease processes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Post-Mortem Examination

### **Autosomal Dominant PKD**

Most common hereditary kidney disease affecting 1 in 400 to 1000. PKD1 chromosome 16 more se-



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vere with earlier ESRD than PKD2 chromosome 4. Progressive cyst growth causes hypertension, pain, hematuria, infections, and eventually ESRD. Screen family members with ultrasound. Tolvaptan may slow cyst growth.

### **Autosomal Dominant Polycystic Kidney Disease**

An inherited disorder causing progressive growth of numerous renal cysts that enlarge the kidneys and destroy parenchyma, leading to hypertension, flank pain, and eventual kidney failure. Associated with hepatic cysts and intracranial aneurysms.

**Synonyms:**  
ADPKD

### **Autosomal Inheritance**

Transmission of a genetic trait through one of the 22 non-sex chromosomes. Autosomal dominant traits may appear in successive generations, whereas autosomal recessive disease generally requires pathogenic variants on both homologous chromosomes.

### **Autosomal Recessive PKD**

Rare childhood disorder from PKHD1 mutation. Bilateral enlarged kidneys with fusiform dilation of collecting ducts. Associated with congenital hepatic fibrosis. Severe forms cause pulmonary hypoplasia in utero. Variable severity from perinatal lethal to presentation in childhood or adolescence.

### **Avascular Necrosis**

Death of bone tissue caused by impaired blood supply. It commonly affects the hip or shoulder and may cause pain, collapse of the joint surface, and arthritis. Risk factors include corticosteroid exposure, alcohol use, trauma, sickle-cell disease, and systemic lupus erythematosus. Treatment depends on the site and stage and may include observation, joint-preserving surgery, or joint replacement.

### **Avascular Necrosis (Osteonecrosis)**

Death of bone tissue caused by impaired blood supply. It commonly affects the femoral head and may lead to subchondral collapse, secondary arthritis, and need for joint-preserving surgery or arthro-

plasty.

**Synonyms:**  
Osteonecrosis Ischemic Bone Necrosis

### **Avian Influenza**

Influenza caused by avian-adapted influenza A viruses, acquired mainly through contact with infected birds or contaminated environments. Human infection can cause severe pneumonia, respiratory failure, and occasionally systemic disease.

### **Avoidant Personality Disorder**

A pattern of social inhibition, feelings of inadequacy, and hypersensitivity to negative evaluation.

### **Avolition**

A severe lack of motivation to initiate and perform self-directed, purposeful activities. It is a negative symptom of schizophrenia and is seen in severe depression. It manifests as neglect of personal hygiene, inability to complete tasks, and social withdrawal.

### **Avulsed Tooth**

A tooth completely displaced from its socket by trauma. It is a dental emergency; management depends on patient age, extraoral dry time, storage medium, root development, and periodontal-ligament viability, and may require urgent replantation by a dental professional.

### **Avulsion**

An injury in which tissue is forcibly torn from the body by shearing or pulling. Common forms include dental, fingertip, nail, and degloving avulsions. Management focuses on hemorrhage control, debridement, tissue preservation, and urgent consultation.

### **Avulsion Fracture**

A fracture in which a fragment of bone is pulled away by the tendon or ligament attached to it, usually during sudden forceful contraction or injury. Common sites include the pelvis, ankle, elbow, and fingers; evaluation considers displacement, joint involvement, skeletal maturity, and associated soft-tissue injury.



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## Awake Fiberoptic Intubation

An intubation technique performed while the patient remains responsive and breathing spontaneously, using topical airway anesthesia and a flexible bronchoscope. It is one option when difficult airway management is anticipated and maintaining oxygenation is important.

## Awareness Under Anesthesia

Unintended awareness or recall of events during general anesthesia. It may involve hearing, sensation, or pain and can be associated with significant psychological distress after the procedure.

## Axilla

Pyramidal space between the upper lateral thorax and medial arm. Bounded by anterior fold (pectoralis major/minor), posterior fold (latissimus dorsi/teres major), medial wall (ribs/serratus anterior), and lateral wall (humerus). Contains axillary artery/vein, brachial plexus cords, and lymph nodes.

## Axillary Artery

The continuation of the subclavian artery, running from the outer border of the first rib to the lower border of teres major, where it becomes the brachial artery. Divided into three parts by the pectoralis minor.

## Axillary Nerve

From posterior cord (C5-C6), passing through the quadrangular space with the posterior circumflex humeral artery. Innervates deltoid and teres minor; provides sensation to the regimental badge area (lateral deltoid skin). Vulnerable in anterior shoulder dislocations and surgical neck humeral fractures.

## Axis

Second cervical vertebra with the dens (odontoid process) projecting superiorly, serving as a pivot for atlas rotation, allowing approximately 50 percent of cervical rotation. Has a large spinous process and flat superior articular facets.

## Axon

The single long process of a neuron that conducts

action potentials away from the cell body toward the axon terminal for synaptic transmission.

## Azole Antifungals

A class of antifungal agents that inhibit the enzyme lanosterol 14- $\alpha$ -demethylase, a cytochrome P450 enzyme essential for ergosterol synthesis in fungal cell membranes. The depletion of ergosterol and accumulation of toxic methylated sterols disrupt membrane integrity and function.

## Azoospermia

Absence of spermatozoa in the ejaculate after appropriate centrifugation and microscopic examination. It may be obstructive, with sperm production preserved but outflow blocked, or nonobstructive, with impaired spermatogenesis.

## Azygos Vein

A vein that drains the posterior intercostal veins and empties into the superior vena cava. It forms an important collateral pathway when the SVC is obstructed. On chest imaging, enlargement of the azygos vein may indicate SVC obstruction, heart failure, or portal hypertension.

## Azygous Vein

A large vein that drains the posterior thoracic wall and mediastinum, ascending along the right side of the vertebral column to empty into the superior vena cava. It provides collateral venous return when the superior or inferior vena cava is obstructed.

## Aarskog Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder affecting growth, facial development, the skeleton, and sometimes the genitals.

## Acute Kidney Failure

A sudden decline in kidney function that causes waste products and fluid to accumulate in the body.

## Addison's Disease

A disorder in which the adrenal glands produce too little cortisol and, often, too little aldosterone.

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**Synonyms:**

Chronic Adrenal Insufficiency Primary Adrenal Insufficiency

**Adrenal Cortex**

The outer part of an adrenal gland that produces steroid hormones, including cortisol and aldosterone.

**Aortic Valve Insufficiency**

Leakage of the aortic valve that allows blood to flow back into the left ventricle.

**Aortic Valve Stenosis**

Narrowing of the aortic valve that obstructs blood flow from the left ventricle into the aorta.

**Synonyms:**

Stenosis, Aortic Valve

**Aortitis**

Inflammation of the aortic wall.

**Arachnoiditis**

Inflammation and scarring of the arachnoid membrane and nearby spinal nerves, often causing chronic pain or neurological symptoms.

**Atrioventricular Block**

Delayed or interrupted electrical conduction between the atria and ventricles of the heart.

**5-Alpha Reductase**

An enzyme that converts testosterone to dihydrotestosterone, a hormone involved in prostate growth and male sexual development.

**Abdominoplasty**

A surgical procedure that removes excess abdominal skin and may tighten the abdominal wall. It is commonly called a tummy tuck.

**Synonyms:**

a tummy tuck.

**Ablation**

Destruction or removal of a small area of abnormal

tissue using methods such as heat, cold, chemicals, or electrical energy.

**Abutment**

A tooth or implant that supports and anchors a dental prosthesis.

**Accommodation**

The ability of the eye to change the shape of its lens so that near objects can be focused clearly.

**Acetaldehyde**

A chemical produced when the body metabolizes alcohol. Accumulation may contribute to flushing, nausea, and vomiting.

**Achilles Tendon**

The strong tendon connecting the calf muscles to the heel bone. It can become inflamed or rupture.

**Acupressure**

Application of pressure to selected body points, usually to relieve symptoms such as pain or nausea.

**Acupuncture**

A treatment in which thin needles are inserted into selected points of the body.

**Acute Pain**

Pain that begins suddenly and usually lasts for a limited period, often because of injury, illness, or a procedure.

**Acute Urinary Retention**

Sudden inability to empty the bladder, often causing painful lower-abdominal distension and requiring urgent assessment.

**Adenosine Triphosphate**

A molecule that stores and transfers energy within cells. It is commonly abbreviated ATP.

**Adhesion**

A band of scar-like tissue that abnormally connects surfaces or organs inside the body.

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### **Advance Care Directive**

A legal document stating a person's preferences for medical care if the person later cannot make or communicate decisions.

### **AIDS Dementia**

A disorder of thinking, memory, behavior, or movement caused by advanced HIV-related disease affecting the brain.

### **Accident And Emergency Medicine (A&E Medicine)**

The medical specialty concerned with the immediate assessment, resuscitation, diagnosis, and initial treatment of acute illness and injury.

#### **Synonyms:**

A&E Medicine

### **Acute Abdomen**

Sudden or severe abdominal pain with clinical features suggesting a potentially serious intra-abdominal disorder that may require urgent investigation or surgery.

### **Acetone**

A volatile ketone body produced during increased fat metabolism. It may contribute to the characteristic breath odor of ketosis and ketoacidosis.

### **Adenitis**

Inflammation of a gland or lymph node, usually caused by infection or an inflammatory disorder. Lymphadenitis is a common form.

### **Adolescence**

The developmental period between childhood and adulthood, involving physical maturation, puberty, and major psychological and social changes.

### **Adrenergic Receptors**

Cell-surface receptors activated by adrenaline and noradrenaline. Alpha and beta subtypes regulate cardiovascular, respiratory, metabolic, and other physiological responses.

### **Aetiology (Etiology)**

The cause or group of causes underlying a disease, injury, or other medical condition.

#### **Synonyms:**

Etiology

### **Afterpains**

Intermittent uterine cramps occurring after childbirth as the uterus contracts and returns toward its pre-pregnancy size. They may be more noticeable during breastfeeding.

### **Agenesis**

Complete failure of an organ or body structure to develop, usually because of a congenital developmental abnormality.

### **Albinism**

An inherited condition involving reduced or absent melanin production, affecting the skin, hair, and eyes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Oculocutaneous Albinism

### **Alopecia Totalis**

Complete loss of hair from the scalp, usually caused by an autoimmune disorder.

### **Alopecia Universalis**

Loss of hair from the entire body, including the scalp, eyebrows, eyelashes, and other hair-bearing areas.

### **Alpha Blockers**

Medicines that block alpha-adrenergic receptors and may lower blood pressure or improve urine flow in prostate enlargement.

### **Alveoli**

Microscopic air sacs in the lungs where oxygen enters the blood and carbon dioxide leaves it.

### **Alzheimer's Disease**

A progressive brain disorder causing deterioration of memory, thinking, behavior, and the ability to

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perform daily activities.

### **Amsler Grid**

A simple chart used to detect or monitor distortions and missing areas in central vision, especially in macular disease.

### **Amyloid**

An abnormal protein that can accumulate in tissues and impair their function in several diseases.

### **Anagen**

The active growth phase of the hair cycle.

### **Analgesia**

Absence or reduction of pain without necessarily causing loss of consciousness.

### **Androgen**

A sex hormone, such as testosterone, that contributes to male reproductive development and other body functions.

### **Angiotensin I**

An inactive precursor that is converted to angiotensin II in the renin-angiotensin system.

### **Angiotensin II**

A hormone that narrows blood vessels and promotes sodium retention, thereby increasing blood pressure.

### **Antibody**

A protein produced by the immune system that specifically binds to a foreign or abnormal substance.

### **Anticoagulant**

A medicine or substance that reduces the blood's ability to form clots.

### **Antidepressant**

A medicine used to treat depressive disorders and some other conditions involving mood, anxiety, pain, or sleep.

### **Antiplatelet Agents**

Medicines that reduce platelet activation or aggregation and thereby lower the risk of some blood clots.

### **Apolipoproteins**

Proteins associated with lipids in the blood that help transport and metabolize cholesterol and triglycerides.

### **Articular Cartilage**

Smooth cartilage covering the ends of bones within a joint, allowing low-friction movement and distributing load.

### **Atrophy**

Reduction in the size and functional capacity of a tissue, organ, or muscle caused by loss or shrinkage of its cells. It may result from disuse, denervation, inadequate blood supply, malnutrition, endocrine deficiency, chronic disease, or aging. Atrophy can be reversible when the underlying cause is corrected, but prolonged injury may produce permanent structural loss and fibrosis. Clinical assessment identifies the distribution, time course, associated weakness or dysfunction, and the underlying neurologic, vascular, nutritional, or systemic cause.

### **Auditory Nerve**

The portion of the vestibulocochlear nerve that carries hearing signals from the inner ear to the brain.

### **Aura**

A temporary sensory, visual, or other neurological symptom that may precede a migraine or seizure.

### **Autoantibodies**

Antibodies that mistakenly react with the body's own cells or tissues.

### **Axon Terminal**

The end of a nerve-cell axon that releases chemical messengers to communicate with another cell.

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### **Achilles Tendinitis**

Painful inflammation or degeneration of the Achilles tendon, usually caused by repeated loading.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tendinitis, Achilles

### **ACL Injury**

A sprain or tear of the anterior cruciate ligament in the knee.

### **Acute Myelogenous Leukemia**

A fast-growing cancer of immature myeloid blood cells in the bone marrow and blood; also called acute myeloid leukemia.

#### **Synonyms:**

acute myeloid leukemia. Leukemia, Acute Myelogenous

### **Acute Radiation Sickness**

Illness caused by a high dose of penetrating radiation received over a short time.

### **Airplane Ear**

Ear pain, pressure, or temporary hearing loss caused by unequal air pressure across the eardrum during flight.

#### **Synonyms:**

Barotitis Media

### **Alcohol Intolerance**

An unpleasant reaction to alcohol caused by difficulty metabolizing alcohol or one of its components.

### **Alcohol Poisoning**

A life-threatening condition caused by drinking enough alcohol to impair breathing, consciousness, and other vital functions.

### **Alpha-Gal Syndrome**

An allergy to the carbohydrate alpha-gal found in most nonhuman mammalian meat and some products derived from mammals.

### **Ampullary Cancer**

Cancer arising in the ampulla of Vater, where the

bile duct and pancreatic duct empty into the small intestine.

### **Appendix Cancer**

Cancer that begins in the appendix, including neuroendocrine tumors, mucinous tumors, and adenocarcinoma.

### **Antibiotic-Associated Diarrhea**

Loose or frequent stools that occur during or soon after antibiotic treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diarrhea, Antibiotic-Associated

### **Asthma Attack**

A sudden worsening of asthma caused by increased airway narrowing and inflammation.

### **Atrioventricular Canal Defect**

A congenital heart defect involving abnormal development of the septum and atrioventricular valves; also called an atrioventricular septal defect.

#### **Synonyms:**

an atrioventricular septal defect. Septal Defect, Atrioventricular

### **Atrioventricular Nodal Reentry Tachycardia**

A rapid regular heart rhythm caused by a reentry circuit near the atrioventricular node; commonly abbreviated AVNRT.

### **Atypical Genitalia**

External genital anatomy that does not have typical male or female features, often because of differences in sex development.

### **Atypical Hyperplasia Of The Breast**

An overgrowth of abnormal cells in breast tissue that is not cancer but may increase future breast-cancer risk.

### **Atypical Teratoid Rhabdoid Tumor**

A rare, aggressive cancer of the central nervous system that occurs mainly in infants and young

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children.

### **Autoimmune Encephalitis**

Brain inflammation caused by antibodies or other immune responses directed against neuronal proteins.

### **Autoimmune Epilepsy**

Recurrent seizures caused by an immune attack on the brain or by inflammation associated with an autoimmune disorder.

### **Abdominal Regions**

The nine named areas used to describe locations on the abdominal wall: the right and left hypochondriac, epigastric, right and left lumbar, umbilical, right and left iliac, and hypogastric regions.

### **Abdominopelvic Cavity**

The continuous body cavity below the diaphragm that contains the abdominal and pelvic organs.

### **Abortifacient**

A drug or substance that induces abortion by ending a pregnancy.

### **Acute Rhinitis**

Sudden inflammation of the nasal lining, commonly caused by a viral infection or an irritant, producing congestion, nasal discharge, and sneezing.

### **Adnexa**

Structures adjacent to an organ; in gynecology, the uterine adnexa include the ovaries, fallopian tubes, and supporting tissues.

### **Adrenogenital Syndrome**

A group of disorders, usually caused by congenital adrenal hyperplasia, in which excess adrenal androgens cause atypical genital development or early puberty.

### **Afferent Neuron**

A sensory nerve cell that carries impulses from receptors toward the central nervous system.

### **Agranulocytes**

White blood cells without prominent cytoplasmic granules; the main types are lymphocytes and monocytes.

### **Airway**

A passage through which air moves between the outside environment and the lungs, including the nose, mouth, pharynx, larynx, trachea, and bronchi.

### **Anastomosis**

A natural or surgically created connection between two tubular structures, such as blood vessels or segments of the intestine.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anastomosis, Intestinal

### **Anastomosis, Intestinal**

Alternate index label; see *Anastomosis*.

### **Allis Clamp**

A toothed surgical clamp used to grasp and hold firm tissue during an operation.

### **Aphagia**

Complete inability to swallow, which may result from neurologic disease, obstruction, severe pain, or loss of swallowing-muscle function.

### **Apical Pulse**

The heart rate measured by listening over the apex of the heart, usually at the left fifth intercostal space near the midclavicular line.

### **Areola**

The pigmented circular area surrounding the nipple. It contains glands that help lubricate and protect the skin during breastfeeding.

### **Asthenia**

Abnormal lack of physical strength or energy. It is a symptom that may occur with illness, malnutrition, or medication effects.



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### **Azotemia**

Accumulation of nitrogen-containing waste products in the blood, usually because the kidneys are not filtering adequately.

### **Atrioventricular Valves**

The heart valves between the atria and ventricles: the tricuspid valve on the right and the mitral valve on the left.

### **Antimicrobial Sensitivity Test**

A laboratory test that determines which antimicrobial medicines inhibit or kill a microorganism isolated from a patient.

### **Antideformity Position**

A therapeutic positioning method that places a limb or joint in an alignment that helps prevent or limit a contracture or deformity.

### **Autosomal Dominant Inheritance**

Inheritance in which one pathogenic variant on a non-sex chromosome can cause a trait or disorder. An affected heterozygous parent may transmit it to about half of the children.

### **Autosomal Recessive Inheritance**

Inheritance in which a disorder generally requires pathogenic variants in both copies of a gene. Carrier parents typically have a one-in-four chance of an affected child in each pregnancy.

### **Abdominal Angina**

Postprandial abdominal pain caused by inadequate blood flow through the arteries supplying the intestines, usually because of atherosclerotic disease.

### **Abdominal Binder**

A wide supportive garment placed around the abdomen to provide gentle compression after surgery, injury, or selected abdominal-wall conditions.

### **Abdominal Migraine**

A migraine-related disorder characterized mainly by recurrent episodes of moderate to severe midline

abdominal pain, often with nausea or vomiting and little or no headache.

### **Abdominocentesis**

Surgical or needle puncture of the abdominal wall to enter the peritoneal cavity, commonly for removal or analysis of ascitic fluid.

### **Abdominal Hernia**

Protrusion of an organ or tissue through a weakness or opening in the abdominal wall. Common types include incisional, umbilical, epigastric, and ventral hernias.

### **Ablative Surgery**

Surgery that destroys or removes abnormal tissue, often using excision, heat, cold, electrical energy, or other tissue-destructive methods.

### **Afferent Loop Syndrome**

Obstruction or impaired emptying of the afferent intestinal limb created by some gastric operations, causing bile and pancreatic-secretions to accumulate with pain, nausea, vomiting, or malabsorption.

### **Acute Chest Syndrome**

A potentially life-threatening pulmonary complication of sickle cell disease characterized by a new lung infiltrate plus fever or respiratory symptoms such as chest pain, cough, hypoxemia, or breathing difficulty.

### **Acute Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyradiculoneuropathy**

The most common form of Guillain-Barré syndrome, in which immune-mediated demyelination of peripheral nerves causes progressive, usually symmetric weakness and reduced reflexes.

### **Acute Nephritic Syndrome**

A clinical syndrome of glomerular inflammation marked by hematuria, variable proteinuria, edema, hypertension, and reduced kidney function.

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### Acute Retroviral Syndrome

The acute illness that may occur shortly after HIV infection, commonly involving fever, rash, sore throat, lymph-node enlargement, muscle aches, or headache.

### Acute Transverse Myelitis

Inflammation across a segment of the spinal cord that can cause rapidly developing weakness, sensory changes, and bladder or bowel dysfunction.

### Adult Polycystic Kidney Disease

An inherited disorder, usually autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease, in which multiple kidney cysts enlarge over time and may cause hypertension, pain, hematuria, and chronic kidney failure.

### Alcohol Withdrawal Syndrome

A set of symptoms occurring after abrupt reduction or cessation of prolonged heavy alcohol use. Symptoms range from tremor, sweating, anxiety, and nausea to seizures and delirium tremens.

### Anemia Of Inflammation

An anemia caused by chronic infection, inflammatory disease, or cancer, involving impaired iron availability, reduced erythropoietin response, and shortened red-cell survival.

### Anterior Cord Syndrome

A spinal-cord injury syndrome causing impaired motor function and loss of pain and temperature sensation below the lesion, with relative preservation of vibration and position sense.

### Adhesiolysis

Surgical division or removal of abnormal fibrous adhesions that bind tissues or organs together, often after inflammation, infection, surgery, or trauma.

### Abulia

Marked reduction in motivation, initiative, and spontaneous activity, usually caused by dysfunction of frontal-subcortical brain circuits or related neurologic disease.

### Acrocyanosis

Persistent, usually painless bluish discoloration and coolness of the hands or feet caused by reduced peripheral blood flow, often worsened by cold exposure.

### Adipsia

Absent or markedly reduced thirst, which can impair normal fluid intake and lead to dehydration or hyponatremia.

### Aerophagia

Excessive swallowing of air, which may cause belching, abdominal bloating, distention, or increased intestinal gas.

### Alpha Thalassemia

An inherited blood disorder caused by reduced production of alpha-globin chains of hemoglobin. Severity ranges from mild microcytosis or anemia to severe fetal or newborn disease.

### Anasarca

Severe, generalized edema involving large areas of the body, often associated with heart failure, kidney disease, liver disease, or profound hypoalbuminemia.

### Abdominal Muscles

The muscles forming the front and sides of the abdominal wall. They support the trunk, help with posture and breathing, and increase intra-abdominal pressure during coughing, lifting, and defecation.

#### Synonyms:

Abdominal wall muscles.

### Acceptance-Based Therapies

Psychotherapeutic approaches that help a person notice and accept thoughts, feelings, or bodily sensations while reducing unhelpful attempts to control or avoid them.

#### Synonyms:

Acceptance-based psychotherapy; acceptance-focused therapy.

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## Acquisition

The process by which new information or a skill is learned and initially encoded, especially in discussions of memory and learning.

### Synonyms:

Learning acquisition; memory acquisition.

## Actin

A structural and contractile protein found in many cells. In muscle, actin interacts with myosin to produce contraction; in other cells, it supports shape, movement, and intracellular transport.

### Synonyms:

Actin filament; microfilament protein.

## Adequate Intake

A recommended average daily nutrient intake based on observed or experimentally determined levels in healthy people when evidence is insufficient to establish a recommended dietary allowance.

### Synonyms:

AI; adequate nutrient intake.

## Adult Day Services

Community-based daytime programs providing supervision, social activities, health-related support, or assistance with daily activities for adults who cannot safely remain alone throughout the day.

### Synonyms:

Adult day care; adult day program.

## Aesthetician

A trained skin-care professional who provides non-medical cosmetic skin treatments, such as cleansing, superficial exfoliation, and selected skin-care procedures within the scope of local regulation.

### Synonyms:

Esthetician; skin-care specialist.

## After-Cataract

Clouding of the posterior lens capsule that develops after cataract surgery and may cause blurred or hazy vision. It is also called posterior capsule opacification.

### Synonyms:

Posterior capsule opacification; secondary cataract.

## Age-Related Cognitive Decline

A modest, age-associated change in memory, processing speed, or other cognitive abilities that does not necessarily interfere substantially with independent daily functioning.

### Synonyms:

Age-associated cognitive decline; normal cognitive aging.

## Alcohol Abuse

A nonpreferred older term for a pattern of alcohol use that causes recurrent problems or harm. Current clinical classification generally uses alcohol use disorder and specifies its severity.

### Synonyms:

Problem drinking; harmful alcohol use.

## Alcohol Dehydrogenase

An enzyme, found mainly in the liver, that catalyzes the first major step in ethanol metabolism by converting alcohol to acetaldehyde.

### Synonyms:

ADH; ethanol dehydrogenase.

## Alcohol Dependence

A pattern of alcohol use characterized by impaired control, compulsive use, tolerance, withdrawal, and continued drinking despite harm. In current terminology, it is generally classified under alcohol use disorder.

### Synonyms:

Alcohol use disorder; alcohol addiction; alcoholism.

## Alendronate

A bisphosphonate that reduces bone resorption and is used to treat or prevent osteoporosis and selected other disorders of excessive bone turnover.

### Synonyms:

Alendronic acid; oral bisphosphonate therapy.

## Alpha Cells

Endocrine cells in the pancreatic islets that produce and release glucagon, a hormone that raises blood

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glucose during fasting or low-glucose states.

**Synonyms:**

Pancreatic alpha cells; glucagon-secreting cells.

### Alpha Hydroxy Acids

A group of organic acids used in dermatology and cosmetics to exfoliate the outer skin layer and improve texture or pigmentation. Examples include glycolic and lactic acid.

**Synonyms:**

AHAs; fruit acids.

### Alpha Waves

Rhythmic electroencephalographic waves, typically around 8–13 Hz, most prominent when a relaxed, awake person has the eyes closed.

**Synonyms:**

Alpha rhythm; posterior dominant rhythm.

### Alpha-Delta Sleep

A sleep pattern in which alpha-frequency activity intrudes into delta-wave deep sleep and may be associated with nonrestorative sleep or chronic pain.

**Synonyms:**

Alpha-delta intrusion; alpha-delta rhythm.

### Amyloid Precursor Protein

A normal transmembrane protein that can be processed into amyloid-beta peptides, which may accumulate in the brain in Alzheimer disease.

**Synonyms:**

APP; amyloid-beta precursor protein.

### Anterior Myocardial Infarction

A myocardial infarction involving the anterior wall of the left ventricle, usually because of obstruction in the left anterior descending coronary artery.

**Synonyms:**

Anterior heart attack; anterior MI.

### Anti-Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide

An autoantibody directed against citrullinated proteins and used, with clinical findings and other tests, to support the diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis.

**Synonyms:**

Anti-CCP antibody; cyclic citrullinated peptide antibody.

### Antileukotriene

A drug class that blocks leukotriene-mediated airway inflammation or bronchoconstriction and is used in selected allergic or respiratory conditions.

**Synonyms:**

Leukotriene modifier; leukotriene pathway inhibitor.

### Antispasmodic Drugs

Medicines that reduce smooth-muscle spasm or cramping in selected gastrointestinal, urinary, biliary, or other conditions. Choice and use depend on the cause and clinical context.

**Synonyms:**

Antispasmodics; spasmolytics.

### Arterial Resistance

The opposition to blood flow produced mainly by the diameter and tone of small arteries and arterioles. It contributes to systemic vascular resistance and blood pressure.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular resistance; systemic vascular resistance.

### Arterioles

Small branches of arteries that regulate blood flow into capillary beds through contraction and relaxation of their smooth muscle.

**Synonyms:**

Resistance vessels; small arteries.

### Atheroma

A localized accumulation of lipid, inflammatory cells, and fibrous tissue within an arterial wall, forming part of an atherosclerotic plaque.

**Synonyms:**

Atheromatous plaque; arterial plaque.

### Atherothrombotic Stroke

An ischemic stroke caused by thrombosis or artery-to-artery embolism arising from atherosclerotic disease in a large artery supplying the brain.

**Synonyms:**

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Large-artery atherosclerotic stroke; atherothrombotic ischemic stroke.

### **Autologous Fat Transplant**

A procedure that removes a person's own fat from one body area and transfers it to another area for soft-tissue volume restoration or contouring.

#### **Synonyms:**

Autologous fat grafting; fat transfer; lipofilling.

### **Axillary**

Relating to the armpit or to structures located in the axilla, including axillary lymph nodes and vessels.

#### **Synonyms:**

Armpit-related; pertaining to the axilla.

### **Arm Pain**

Pain in the shoulder, upper arm, elbow, forearm, or related tissues. Causes include muscle or tendon injury, nerve compression, arthritis, vascular disease, and referred pain; sudden severe pain with chest discomfort, weakness, or shortness of breath requires urgent assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain in the arm; upper-limb pain.

### **Acute Flaccid Myelitis (AFM)**

A rare neurologic condition causing sudden weakness and loss of muscle tone, usually affecting the arms or legs and sometimes the face or breathing muscles.

### **Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD) In Children**

A childhood neurodevelopmental disorder involving persistent inattention, hyperactivity, impulsivity, or combinations of these symptoms that impair functioning.

### **Adult Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)**

ADHD that persists into adulthood, often affecting attention, organization, impulse control, activity level, and daily functioning.

### **Adnexal Tumors And Masses**

Abnormal growths or masses involving the ovary, fallopian tube, or nearby supporting tissues; they may be benign or malignant.

### **Adult Still Disease**

A systemic inflammatory disorder characterized by fever, joint pain or arthritis, and a transient salmon-colored rash.

### **Age Spots (Liver Spots)**

Flat brown, gray, or black skin spots caused by long-term ultraviolet exposure, usually appearing on sun-exposed areas.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lentigines, Solar Solar Lentigines

### **Anaplastic Large Cell Lymphoma**

A rare T-cell non-Hodgkin lymphoma characterized by large abnormal lymphocytes and expression of the CD30 marker; it may be systemic or skin-limited.

### **Alcoholic Hepatitis (Alcohol-Associated Hepatitis)**

Inflammation and injury of the liver related to alcohol use, potentially causing jaundice, abdominal pain, fever, and liver failure.

### **Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS)**

A progressive neurodegenerative disease that damages motor neurons, causing muscle weakness, loss of movement, speech or swallowing difficulty, and eventually respiratory failure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lou Gehrig's Disease

### **Aneurysms**

Abnormal bulges or enlargements in weakened areas of blood-vessel walls that may enlarge, clot, dissect, or rupture.

### **Angina**

Chest discomfort caused by inadequate oxygen-rich blood flow to the heart muscle, usually from coro-

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nary artery disease.

### **Anorgasmia In Women**

Persistent or recurrent difficulty achieving orgasm despite adequate sexual stimulation, causing personal distress.

### **Anterior Vaginal Prolapse (Cystocele)**

Bulging of the front wall of the vagina caused by weakening of the tissue supporting the bladder, sometimes producing urinary symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bladder Prolapse Prolapsed Bladder

### **Anxiety Disorders**

Mental health disorders involving excessive fear, worry, or anxiety that is persistent, difficult to control, and disruptive to daily life.

### **Aortic Valve Regurgitation**

Backward leakage of blood through an incompletely closing aortic valve, which can make the heart work harder and eventually cause heart failure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Regurgitation, Aortic Valve

### **Auditory Processing Disorder**

Difficulty recognizing or interpreting sounds despite normal or near-normal hearing sensitivity.

### **Arteriosclerosis / Atherosclerosis**

Arteriosclerosis is hardening and thickening of arteries; atherosclerosis is plaque buildup within artery walls that can restrict blood flow.

### **Atrial Septal Defect (ASD)**

A congenital opening between the heart's upper chambers that permits abnormal blood flow between the atria.

### **Atrioventricular Nodal Reentry Tachycardia (AVNRT)**

A rapid regular heart rhythm caused by a reentrant electrical circuit involving or near the atrioventricular node.

### **Atypical Teratoid Rhabdoid Tumor (ATRT)**

A rare aggressive cancer of the central nervous system, most often occurring in infants and young children.

### **A Fib**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Atrial fibrillation*.

### **AAT Deficiency**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alpha-1-antitrypsin deficiency*.

### **AATD**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alpha-1-antitrypsin deficiency*.

### **Abnormally Excessive Sweating**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Hyperhidrosis*.

### **Abscess, Bartholin's**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Bartholin's cyst*.

### **Acid Reflux, Infant**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Infant reflux*.

### **Acne Inversa**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Hidradenitis suppurativa*.

### **Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *HIV/AIDS*.

### **Acute Granulocytic Leukemia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute myelogenous leukemia*.

### **Acute Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyneuropathy**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Guillain-Barre syndrome*.

### **Acute Lymphoid Leukemia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute lymphocytic*



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*leukemia.*

### **Acute Myeloblastic Leukemia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute myelogenous leukemia.*

### **Acute Nonlymphocytic Leukemia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute myelogenous leukemia.*

### **Acute Radiation Syndrome**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Radiation sickness.*

### **Acute Renal Failure**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute kidney injury.*

### **Acute Rhinosinusitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute sinusitis.*

### **Acute Symptomatic Seizures Secondary To Autoimmune Encephalitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Autoimmune epilepsy.*

### **Addiction, Alcohol**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alcohol use disorder.*

### **Addiction, Gambling**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Compulsive gambling.*

### **Addiction, Nicotine**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Nicotine dependence.*

### **Adenitis, Mesenteric**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Mesenteric lymphadenitis.*

### **ADHD In Children**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) in children.*

### **ADHD, Adult**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Adult attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD).*

### **Adolescent Schizophrenia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Childhood schizophrenia.*

### **Adrenal Mass**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Benign adrenal tumors.*

### **AE**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Autoimmune encephalitis.*

### **AFM**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Acute flaccid myelitis (AFM).*

### **Age-Related Macular Degeneration, Dry**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Dry macular degeneration.*

### **Age-Related Macular Degeneration, Wet**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Wet macular degeneration.*

### **Agnogenic Myeloid Metaplasia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Myelofibrosis.*

### **AIDP**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Guillain-Barre syndrome.*

### **AIDS/HIV**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *HIV/AIDS.*

### **ALCL**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Anaplastic large cell lymphoma.*

### **Alcohol Addiction**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alcohol use disorder.*

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### **Alcohol-Associated Hepatitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alcoholic hepatitis* (*Alcohol-associated hepatitis*).

### **Allergic Granulomatosis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *EGPA* (*formerly Churg-Strauss syndrome*).

### **Allergic Granulomatosis And Angiitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *EGPA* (*formerly Churg-Strauss syndrome*).

### **Allergy, Dust Mite**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Dust mite allergy*.

### **Allergy, Egg**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Egg allergy*.

### **Allergy, Food**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Food allergy*.

### **Allergy, Latex**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Latex allergy*.

### **Allergy, Milk**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Milk allergy*.

### **Allergy, Mold**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Mold allergy*.

### **Allergy, Nickel**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Nickel allergy*.

### **Allergy, Peanut**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Peanut allergy*.

### **Allergy, Penicillin**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Penicillin allergy*.

### **Allergy, Pet**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Pet allergy*.

### **Allergy, Shellfish**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Shellfish allergy*.

### **Allergy, Wheat**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Wheat allergy*.

### **Alpha 1**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Alpha-1-antitrypsin deficiency*.

### **Alveolar Osteitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Dry socket*.

### **American Trypanosomiasis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Chagas disease*.

### **Amnesia, Transient Global**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Transient global amnesia*.

### **Amnestic Syndrome**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Amnesia*.

### **Amyloid Disease**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Amyloidosis*.

### **Angiitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Vasculitis*.

### **Angioblastoma**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Hemangioblastoma*.

### **Angioedema And Hives**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Hives and angioedema*.

### **Angiofollicular Lymph Node Hyperplasia**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Castleman disease*.

### **Anterior Vaginal Prolapse**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Anterior vaginal prolapse* (*cystocele*).

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### **Antibiotic-Associated Colitis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Pseudomembranous colitis*.

### **Anxiety Disorder, Generalized**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Generalized anxiety disorder*.

### **Anxiety Disorder, Social**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Social anxiety disorder (social phobia)*.

### **Aortic Aneurysm, Abdominal**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Abdominal aortic aneurysm*.

### **Aortic Insufficiency**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Aortic valve regurgitation*.

### **APD**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Auditory processing disorder*.

### **Aphasia, Primary Progressive**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Primary progressive aphasia*.

### **Apical Ballooning Syndrome**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Broken heart syndrome*.

### **APS**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Antiphospholipid syndrome*.

### **Arenaviruses**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Viral hemorrhagic fevers*.

### **Argentine Hemorrhagic Fever**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Viral hemorrhagic fevers*.

### **Arm Fracture**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Broken arm*.

### **Arteritis, Giant Cell**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Giant cell arteritis*.

### **Arteritis, Takayasu's**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Takayasu's arteritis*.

### **Arthritis, Basal Joint**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Thumb arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Degenerative**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Osteoarthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Gouty**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Gout*.

### **Arthritis, Infectious**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Septic arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Juvenile Idiopathic**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Juvenile idiopathic arthritis (JIA)*.

### **Arthritis, Osteoarthritis**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Osteoarthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Psoriatic**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Psoriatic arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Reactive**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Reactive arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Rheumatoid**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Rheumatoid arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Septic**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Septic arthritis*.

### **Arthritis, Thumb**

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Thumb arthritis*.

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## ASD

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Atrial septal defect (ASD)*.

## Aseptic Necrosis

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Avascular necrosis (osteonecrosis)*.

### Synonyms:

Avascular Necrosis (Aseptic Necrosis)

## Asthma, Childhood

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Childhood asthma*.

## Asthma, Exercise-Induced

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Exercise-induced asthma*.

## Asthma, Occupational

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Occupational asthma*.

## Atresia Of Bile Ducts

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Biliary atresia*.

## ATRT

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Atypical teratoid rhabdoid tumor (ATRT)*.

## Atypical Teratoid/Rhabdoid Tumor Brain Cancer

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Atypical teratoid rhabdoid tumor (ATRT)*.

## Attachment Disorder

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Reactive attachment disorder*.

## Auditory Information Processing Disorder

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Auditory processing disorder*.

## Autoimmune Associated Epilepsy

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Autoimmune*

*epilepsy*.

## Autoimmune Encephalopathy

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Autoimmune encephalitis*.

## AVN

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Avascular necrosis (osteonecrosis)*.

## AVNRT

Alternate Mayo Clinic label; see *Atrioventricular nodal reentry tachycardia (AVNRT)*.

## A Guide To Clinical Trials For Cancer

An educational resource explaining clinical trials for cancer, including study purpose, eligibility, consent, benefits, risks, and questions for the research team.

## A Guide To Help Children Understand Cancer

Patient information concerning a guide to help children understand cancer .

## A Guide To Herbal Remedies

An educational resource about herbal products, their possible uses, adverse effects, interactions, and the importance of discussing them with a healthcare professional.

## A1C Test

A1C test measures glycated hemoglobin, the fraction of hemoglobin with glucose attached, to estimate average blood glucose over roughly the preceding 2 to 3 months.

## Aase Syndrome

Aase syndrome is a rare inherited disorder characterized by congenital hypoplastic anemia and distinctive skeletal abnormalities.

## Abdomen - Swollen

A symptom or clinical concern involving abdomen - Swollen; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical

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assessment.

### **Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Repair - Open**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Repair - Open; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Repair - Open - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after abdominal aortic aneurysm repair - open. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Abdominal CT Scan**

A computed tomography study that produces cross-sectional images of abdominal using X-rays. It can identify structural abnormalities, injury, inflammation, bleeding, or masses.

### **Abdominal Exploration**

Surgical inspection of the abdominal cavity to identify or treat a suspected source of pain, bleeding, infection, obstruction, or other disease.

### **Abdominal MRI Scan**

A magnetic resonance imaging study that produces detailed images of abdominal using magnetic fields and radiofrequency energy.

### **Abdominal Pain - Children Under Age 12**

A clinical topic concerning abdominal Pain - Children Under Age 12; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Abdominal Radiation - Discharge**

A clinical topic concerning abdominal Radiation - Discharge; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Abdominal Sounds**

Sounds produced by movement of gas and fluid through the intestines; changes in frequency or character may support, but do not establish, a diagnosis.

### **Abdominal Tap**

A clinical topic concerning abdominal Tap; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Abdominal Thrusts**

First-aid maneuver used for severe choking in a conscious person, intended to expel an obstructing object from the airway.

### **Abdominal Ultrasound**

An ultrasound examination that uses sound waves to produce images of abdominal and assess its structure and blood flow when applicable.

### **Abdominal Wall Fat Pad Biopsy**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from abdominal wall fat pad for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Abdominal Wall Surgery**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving abdominal Wall Surgery; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Abnormal Hemoglobins Testing**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate abnormal Hemoglobins Testing; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Abnormally Dark Or Light Skin**

A symptom or clinical concern involving abnormally Dark Or Light Skin; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Abortion - Medication**

Medication abortion uses prescribed medicines, commonly mifepristone followed by misoprostol or miso-

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proctol alone, to end an early intrauterine pregnancy; confirmation of completion and assessment for ectopic pregnancy are important.

### **Abortion - Procedure**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving abortion - Procedure; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Abortion - Procedure - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after abortion - procedure. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Abscess - Abdomen Or Pelvis**

A localized collection of pus within the abdominal or pelvic cavity, usually caused by infection or leakage from an injured or inflamed organ. It may cause pain, fever, and sepsis and often requires antimicrobial treatment and drainage.

### **Absence Of Sweating**

A symptom or clinical concern involving absence Of Sweating; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Absent Menstrual Periods - Primary**

Primary amenorrhea, meaning failure to have the first menstrual period by the expected age. Causes include chromosomal or reproductive-tract abnormalities, endocrine disorders, chronic disease, and inadequate energy availability.

### **Absent Menstrual Periods - Secondary**

Secondary amenorrhea, meaning absence of menstrual periods for an extended interval in a person who previously menstruated. Pregnancy is considered first; other causes include endocrine disease, medications, stress, weight change, and ovarian dysfunction.

### **Absent Pulmonary Valve**

Absent pulmonary valve is a congenital heart defect in which the pulmonary valve is missing or severely underdeveloped, often causing pulmonary-artery enlargement and respiratory symptoms.

### **ACE Blood Test**

ACE blood test measures angiotensin-converting enzyme in serum; it may support evaluation of sarcoidosis and selected granulomatous or liver disorders but is not diagnostic alone.

### **ACE Inhibitors**

ACE inhibitors block formation of angiotensin II and are used for hypertension, heart failure, diabetic kidney protection, and selected cardiovascular conditions.

### **Acetaminophen And Codeine Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Acetaminophen and codeine. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Acetaminophen Dosing For Children**

Weight-based dosing guidance for acetaminophen in children; the total daily dose must account for all combination products to avoid liver toxicity.

### **Acetaminophen Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Acetaminophen. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Acetone Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Acetone poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Acetylcholine Receptor Antibody**

Acetylcholine receptor antibody testing detects antibodies associated with autoimmune myasthenia



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gravis and is interpreted with the neurologic examination and other studies.

### **Aches And Pains During Pregnancy**

A symptom or clinical concern involving aches And Pains During Pregnancy; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Achilles Tendon Repair**

Achilles tendon repair reconnects a ruptured Achilles tendon, followed by immobilization and graduated rehabilitation to restore plantar-flexion strength.

### **Achilles Tendon Rupture - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after achilles tendon rupture. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Acid Loading Test (PH)**

A test of the kidney's ability to excrete acid after an acid load, used in evaluating renal tubular acidification disorders.

### **Acid Mucopolysaccharides**

An older term for glycosaminoglycans, long carbohydrate chains in connective-tissue substances such as cartilage, skin, and synovial fluid. Abnormal degradation or storage can cause mucopolysaccharidoses.

### **Acid Soldering Flux Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Acid soldering flux poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Acid-Fast Stain**

Acid-fast stain uses dyes that remain in the cell wall of mycobacteria and some related organisms, helping identify them in clinical specimens.

### **ACL Reconstruction - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symp-

tom management after acl reconstruction. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Acne - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after acne. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Acquired Platelet Function Defect**

Impaired platelet adhesion or aggregation that develops after birth. Causes include antiplatelet medicines, kidney failure, hematologic disease, and other systemic disorders; platelet counts may remain normal, but mucocutaneous bleeding can occur.

### **Acrodysostosis**

A rare genetic skeletal dysplasia characterized by short, broad fingers and toes, nasal and midface hypoplasia, short stature, and variable intellectual disability. Some patients have resistance to parathyroid or other hormones.

### **ACTH Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures acth or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Acute Adrenal Crisis**

Acute adrenal crisis is life-threatening cortisol deficiency causing hypotension, vomiting, abdominal pain, electrolyte disturbance, hypoglycemia, or shock; urgent glucocorticoid and fluid treatment is required.

### **Acute Arterial Occlusion - Kidney**

Acute arterial occlusion of the kidney abruptly reduces renal blood flow and may cause flank pain, hematuria, hypertension, or acute kidney injury.

### **Acute Cerebellar Ataxia**

Sudden or rapidly developing incoordination caused by cerebellar dysfunction. In children it may follow an infection, but stroke, intoxication, inflammation,

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tumor, and other urgent causes must be considered.

### **Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia (ALL)**

Acute lymphoblastic leukemia is a rapidly progressive cancer of immature lymphoid precursor cells that crowds the bone marrow and can involve blood, lymph nodes, or the central nervous system.

### **Acute Myeloid Leukemia (AML) - Children**

Childhood acute myeloid leukemia is a marrow and blood cancer caused by uncontrolled proliferation of immature myeloid cells, producing anemia, infection, and bleeding risk.

### **Acute Myeloid Leukemia - Adult**

Adult acute myeloid leukemia is an aggressive malignancy of myeloid blood-cell precursors that impairs normal blood-cell production.

### **Adenoid Removal**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving adenoid Removal; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Adolescent Development**

A clinical topic concerning adolescent Development; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Adolescent Test Or Procedure Preparation**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving adolescent Test Or Procedure Preparation; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Adrenal Gland Removal**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving adrenal Gland Removal; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Adrenal Glands**

Adrenal glands sit above the kidneys and produce cortisol, aldosterone, adrenal androgens, and catecholamines that regulate stress, blood pressure, salt balance, and metabolism.

### **Adrenergic Bronchodilator Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Adrenergic bronchodilator. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Adult Soft Tissue Sarcoma**

A malignant tumor arising from connective or supporting tissues, such as muscle, fat, fibrous tissue, blood vessels, or peripheral nerves. It often presents as a painless enlarging mass and requires imaging and biopsy for diagnosis.

### **Advance Care Directives**

Documents and instructions that state a person's healthcare preferences and designate a surrogate decision-maker if the person later lacks decision-making capacity.

### **Aerobic Bacteria**

Bacteria that grow using oxygen or tolerate oxygen, although individual species differ in their exact oxygen requirements.

### **Aflatoxin**

Aflatoxin is a toxin produced by certain *Aspergillus* molds in contaminated foods; chronic exposure can injure the liver and increase hepatocellular-carcinoma risk.

### **After A C-Section - In The Hospital**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after after a c-section. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **After A Fall In The Hospital**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symp-

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tom management after after a fall in the hospital. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **After An Exposure To Sharps Or Body Fluids**

Post-exposure evaluation after possible contact with blood or body fluids, including wound care, source assessment, and timely consideration of HIV, hepatitis B, or hepatitis C prevention and testing.

### **After Chemotherapy - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after after chemotherapy. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **After Vaginal Delivery - In The Hospital**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after after vaginal delivery. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **After Weight-Loss Surgery - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Patient education about recovery after weight-loss surgery, including diet progression, activity, medicines, warning signs, and follow-up.

### **Aftershave Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Aftershave poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Age-Related Hearing Loss**

A symptom or clinical concern involving age-Related Hearing Loss; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Aging Changes In Body Shape**

Age-related changes involving body shape. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle,

and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Hair And Nails**

Age-related changes involving hair and nails. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Hormone Production**

Age-related changes involving hormone production. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Immunity**

Age-related changes involving immunity. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Organs, Tissue And Cells**

Age-related changes involving organs, tissue and cells. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Skin**

Age-related changes involving skin. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Sleep**

Age-related changes involving sleep. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Teeth And Gums**

Age-related changes involving teeth and gums. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Bones - Muscles - Joints**

Age-related changes involving the bones - muscles - joints. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

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### **Aging Changes In The Breast**

Age-related changes involving the breast. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Face**

Age-related changes involving the face. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Female Reproductive System**

Age-related changes involving the female reproductive system. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Heart And Blood Vessels**

Age-related changes involving the heart and blood vessels. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Kidneys And Bladder**

Age-related changes involving the kidneys and bladder. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Lungs**

Age-related changes involving the lungs. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Male Reproductive System**

Age-related changes involving the male reproductive system. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Nervous System**

Age-related changes involving the nervous system. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In The Senses**

Age-related changes involving the senses. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Changes In Vital Signs**

Age-related changes involving vital signs. The changes vary with age, health, medicines, lifestyle, and coexisting disease.

### **Aging Spots - Should You Be Concerned?**

A topic about age-related lentigines, which are usually flat brown skin patches caused by cumulative sun exposure. A changing or bleeding lesion requires assessment.

### **Aicardi Syndrome**

Aicardi Syndrome is a rare developmental brain disorder classically involving agenesis of the corpus callosum, chorioretinal lacunae, and infantile seizures.

### **Alanine Transaminase (ALT) Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures alanine transaminase or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Albumin Blood (Serum) Test**

A laboratory test that measures albumin or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Alcohol And Pregnancy**

Alcohol crosses the placenta and can cause fetal alcohol spectrum disorders; no known amount or timing during pregnancy is established as safe.

### **Alcohol Use And Safe Drinking**

Guidance on reducing alcohol-related harm, including standard-drink awareness, lower-risk limits, and situations in which alcohol should be avoided.

### **Alcohol Use Disorder - Resources**

Information about alcohol use disorder and avail-

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able assessment, treatment, recovery, and support resources.

### **Alcoholic Liver Disease**

Alcoholic liver disease includes steatosis, alcohol-associated hepatitis, and cirrhosis caused by sustained alcohol exposure.

### **Aldolase Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures aldolase or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Aldosterone Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures aldosterone or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Allergic Rhinitis - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after allergic rhinitis. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Allergic Rhinitis - What To Ask Your Doctor - Adult**

A patient discussion topic about allergic rhinitis, including symptoms, triggers, treatment options, and questions about diagnosis and follow-up.

### **Allergic Rhinitis - What To Ask Your Doctor - Child**

A patient discussion topic about allergic rhinitis, including symptoms, triggers, treatment options, and questions about diagnosis and follow-up.

### **Allergies, Asthma, And Dust**

Dust can carry allergens such as dust-mite particles that trigger allergic rhinitis or asthma in susceptible people. Symptoms may include sneezing, congestion, wheezing, cough, and shortness of breath.

### **Allergies, Asthma, And Molds**

Mold spores and fragments can trigger allergic rhini-

tis, conjunctivitis, or asthma in sensitized people. Reducing exposure and treating the specific allergic or airway condition are guided by clinical assessment.

### **Allergies, Asthma, And Pollen**

Pollen is a seasonal airborne allergen that can trigger allergic rhinitis, conjunctivitis, or asthma. Typical symptoms include sneezing, itchy eyes, nasal congestion, cough, and wheezing.

### **Allergy Shots**

Subcutaneous allergen immunotherapy involving gradually increasing doses of selected allergens to reduce allergic sensitivity; administration requires monitoring for systemic reactions.

### **Allergy Testing - Skin**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate allergy Testing - Skin; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Aloe**

A plant-derived substance used in some topical products and supplements; topical preparations may soothe minor irritation, while oral latex-containing products can cause cramps, diarrhea, and electrolyte problems.

### **ALP - Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures alp - or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **ALP Isoenzyme Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate aLP Isoenzyme Test; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures alpha-1 antitrypsin or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

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## ALS - Resources

Information and support resources for amyotrophic lateral sclerosis, including symptom management, rehabilitation, assistive care, and caregiver support.

## Alstrom Syndrome

A rare autosomal-recessive disorder caused by ALMS1 variants, associated with cone-rod dystrophy, hearing loss, obesity, insulin resistance, cardiomyopathy, and progressive kidney or liver disease.

## Alternative Medicine - Pain Relief

A clinical topic concerning alternative Medicine - Pain Relief; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

## Alveolar Abnormalities

Structural or functional changes in the lung alveoli that can impair gas exchange and occur with infection, edema, emphysema, interstitial disease, or developmental disorders.

## Alzheimer Disease - Resources

Alzheimer disease resources provide education about progressive cognitive decline, caregiver support, safety, advance planning, and available treatment and services.

## Am I In Labor?

Information about possible labor, including regular painful contractions, rupture of membranes, bloody show, and indications for contacting the maternity team.

## Amino Acids

Amino acids are organic molecules that form proteins and also serve as precursors or fuels in human metabolism.

## Aminoaciduria

Aminoaciduria is abnormal urinary loss of amino acids caused by renal tubular transport defects, inherited metabolic disease, or generalized tubular

injury.

## Aminophylline Overdose

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Aminophylline. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Amitriptyline And Perphenazine Overdose

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Amitriptyline and perphenazine. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Amitriptyline Hydrochloride Overdose

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Amitriptyline hydrochloride. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Ammonia Blood Test

A laboratory test that measures ammonia or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## Ammonia Poisoning

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Ammonia poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Ammonium Hydroxide Poisoning

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Ammonium hydroxide poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Amniotic Band Sequence

Amniotic band sequence results when fibrous amniotic strands entangle developing fetal parts, producing constriction rings, limb defects, or craniofacial



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and body-wall abnormalities.

### **Amniotic Constriction Bands**

Alternate descriptive label; see *Amniotic band sequence*.

### **Amylase - Blood**

A blood test measuring amylase, an enzyme produced mainly by the pancreas and salivary glands; elevated values may occur in pancreatitis and other conditions.

### **Amylase - Urine**

A urine test measuring amylase excretion, sometimes used with blood amylase when evaluating pancreatic or salivary-gland disease.

### **Anal Itching - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after anal itching. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Anemia Caused By Low Iron - Children**

Iron-deficiency anemia in a child caused by insufficient iron intake, increased requirements, blood loss, or impaired absorption. It reduces hemoglobin production and may cause pallor, fatigue, irritability, or impaired development.

### **Anemia Caused By Low Iron - Infants And Toddlers**

Iron-deficiency anemia in an infant or toddler, commonly related to inadequate dietary iron, excessive cow's milk intake, increased growth requirements, or blood loss. It may cause pallor, fatigue, irritability, and developmental effects.

### **Anesthesia - What To Ask Your Doctor - Adult**

A patient discussion topic about anesthesia, including the planned technique, preparation, risks, medicines, and recovery.

### **Anesthesia - What To Ask Your Doctor -**

### **Child**

A patient discussion topic about anesthesia, including the planned technique, preparation, risks, medicines, and recovery.

### **Aneurysm In The Brain**

A brain aneurysm is a focal weakness and ballooning of a cerebral-artery wall; rupture causes subarachnoid hemorrhage and sudden severe headache.

### **Angina - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after angina. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Angina - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient discussion topic about angina, including symptom pattern, emergency warning signs, testing, treatment, and prevention.

### **Angina - When You Have Chest Pain**

Angina with chest pain reflects transient myocardial ischemia; new, severe, prolonged, or rest pain may signal acute coronary syndrome and requires emergency assessment.

### **Angiodysplasia Of The Colon**

A degenerative abnormality of small blood vessels in the colon that can cause intermittent or recurrent lower gastrointestinal bleeding, often without pain. Diagnosis and treatment depend on the bleeding pattern and endoscopic findings.

### **Angioplasty And Stent - Heart - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after angioplasty and stent - heart. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Angioplasty And Stent Placement - Carotid Artery**

A clinical topic concerning angioplasty And Stent Placement - Carotid Artery; assessment and man-

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agement depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Angioplasty And Stent Placement - Carotid Artery - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after angioplasty and stent placement - carotid artery. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Angioplasty And Stent Placement - Heart**

A clinical topic concerning angioplasty And Stent Placement - Heart; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Angioplasty And Stent Placement - Peripheral Arteries**

A clinical topic concerning angioplasty And Stent Placement - Peripheral Arteries; assessment and management depend on the specific clinical question, findings, and patient context.

### **Angioplasty And Stent Placement - Peripheral Arteries - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after angioplasty and stent placement - peripheral arteries. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Animal Bites - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after animal bites. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Ankle Arthroscopy**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving ankle Arthroscopy; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Ankle Fracture - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after ankle fracture. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Ankle Replacement**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving ankle Replacement; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Ankle Replacement - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after ankle replacement. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Ankle Sprain - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after ankle sprain. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Anomalous Left Coronary Artery From The Pulmonary Artery**

A rare congenital anomaly in which the left coronary artery arises from the pulmonary artery instead of the aorta. It can cause myocardial ischemia, heart failure, arrhythmia, or sudden death, particularly in infancy or exertion.

### **Anorchia**

Complete absence of testicular tissue, present from birth or caused by loss of previously formed testes. It results in absent or severely reduced testosterone production and infertility unless treated with appropriate hormone replacement.

### **Anoscopy And High-Resolution Anoscopy**

An examination of the anal canal and lower rectum using an anoscope; high-resolution anoscopy provides magnified views for evaluation of abnormal tissue.

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### **Anterior Cruciate Ligament (ACL) Injury**

A sprain or tear of the ligament that limits forward movement and rotation of the tibia relative to the femur. It commonly occurs during sudden stopping, pivoting, or landing and may cause a pop, rapid swelling, pain, and knee instability.

### **Anterior Cruciate Ligament (ACL) Injury - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after anterior cruciate ligament (acl) injury. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Anterior Knee Pain**

A symptom or clinical concern involving anterior Knee Pain; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Anterior Vaginal Wall Repair**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving anterior Vaginal Wall Repair; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Anthrax Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures anthrax or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Anti-DNase B Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures anti-dnase b or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Anti-Glomerular Basement Membrane Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures anti-glomerular basement membrane or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Anti-Glomerular Basement Membrane Disease**

An autoimmune disease in which antibodies target basement-membrane components in the kidney and sometimes the lungs. It can cause rapidly progressive glomerulonephritis, pulmonary hemorrhage, or both and requires urgent treatment.

### **Anti-Insulin Antibody Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate anti-Insulin Antibody Test; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Anti-Reflux Surgery - Children**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving anti-Reflux Surgery - Children; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Anti-Reflux Surgery - Children - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after anti-reflux surgery - children. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Anti-Reflux Surgery - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after anti-reflux surgery. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

### **Anti-Rust Product Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Anti-rust product poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Anti-Smooth Muscle Antibody**

An autoantibody associated especially with autoimmune hepatitis, although low levels can occur in other autoimmune or infectious conditions.

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### **Antibody Titer Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures antibody titer or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Anticoagulant Rodenticides Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Anticoagulant rodenticides poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Antidiarrheal Medicine Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Antidiarrheal medicine. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Antidiuretic Hormone Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures antidiuretic hormone or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Antifreeze Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Antifreeze poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Antihistamines For Allergies**

Medicines that block histamine effects and reduce symptoms such as itching, sneezing, and runny nose; sedation and interactions vary by agent.

### **Antimitochondrial Antibody**

An autoantibody strongly associated with primary biliary cholangitis, interpreted with cholestatic liver tests and clinical findings.

### **Antinuclear Antibody Panel**

A laboratory test that measures antinuclear anti-

body panel or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Antiparietal Cell Antibody Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate antiparietal Cell Antibody Test; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Antiphospholipid Syndrome - APS**

Antiphospholipid syndrome is an autoimmune thrombophilia associated with venous or arterial clots and pregnancy morbidity in the presence of persistent antiphospholipid antibodies.

### **Antiplatelet Medicines - P2Y12 Inhibitors**

Antiplatelet drugs such as clopidogrel, prasugrel, and ticagrelor that reduce ADP-mediated platelet activation and thrombosis risk, with bleeding as a major adverse effect.

### **Antithrombin III Blood Test**

A laboratory test that measures antithrombin iii or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Antithyroglobulin Antibody Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate antithyroglobulin Antibody Test; interpretation depends on the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Aortic Aneurysm Repair - Endovascular**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving aortic Aneurysm Repair - Endovascular; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Aortic Aneurysm Repair - Endovascular - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after aortic aneurysm repair - endovascular. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and

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follow-up plan.

### **Aortic Angiography**

An imaging study of blood vessels that uses contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or abnormal blood flow.

### **Aortic Arch Syndrome**

Symptoms and signs caused by narrowing or blockage of the aorta or its major branches. Causes include large-vessel vasculitis, atherosclerosis, thrombosis, and congenital disease; findings may include unequal pulses, limb claudication, or neurologic symptoms.

### **Aortic Valve Surgery - Minimally Invasive**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving aortic Valve Surgery - Minimally Invasive; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Aortic Valve Surgery - Open**

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving aortic Valve Surgery - Open; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

### **Aplastic**

Describing failure of a tissue, especially bone marrow, to produce adequate cells; aplastic anemia causes pancytopenia from marrow failure.

### **Apolipoprotein B100**

The structural apolipoprotein on atherogenic particles such as LDL and VLDL; its concentration reflects the number of potentially atherogenic lipoprotein particles.

### **Apolipoprotein CII**

A cofactor required to activate lipoprotein lipase, the enzyme that hydrolyzes triglycerides in circulating lipoproteins.

### **Apoplexy**

An older term for sudden loss of neurologic function,

historically referring to stroke and sometimes used for hemorrhage or infarction in an organ.

### **Appetite - Decreased**

A symptom or clinical concern involving appetite - Decreased; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Appetite - Increased**

A symptom or clinical concern involving appetite - Increased; evaluation considers onset, severity, associated findings, possible causes, and need for medical assessment.

### **Appropriate For Gestational Age (AGA)**

Describing a fetus or newborn whose estimated weight or size falls within the expected reference range for the gestational age, commonly between the 10th and 90th percentiles.

### **Arachnodactyly**

Abnormally long and slender fingers or toes. It may occur as an isolated trait or as a feature of connective-tissue disorders such as Marfan syndrome.

### **Are You Getting Too Much Exercise?**

Information about excessive exercise, which may cause persistent fatigue, declining performance, sleep disturbance, recurrent injury, or menstrual changes. Recovery and clinical assessment may be needed.

### **Arm CT Scan**

A computed tomography study that produces cross-sectional images of arm using X-rays. It can identify structural abnormalities, injury, inflammation, bleeding, or masses.

### **Arm MRI Scan**

A magnetic resonance imaging study that produces detailed images of arm using magnetic fields and radiofrequency energy.

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## Arrhythmias

Abnormal heart rhythms caused by altered impulse formation or conduction; they range from harmless premature beats to rhythms that impair circulation.

## Arterial Embolism

Sudden blockage of an artery by material carried through the bloodstream, usually a blood clot. It can cause acute limb, brain, kidney, intestinal, or other organ ischemia and requires urgent assessment.

### Synonyms:

Arterial Thromboembolism

## Arterial Thromboembolism

Alternate index label; see *Arterial embolism*.

## Arterial Stick

Needle puncture of an artery, usually to obtain blood for arterial blood-gas or related testing; bleeding and arterial injury are possible complications.

## Arteriogram

An imaging study of blood vessels that uses contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or abnormal blood flow.

## Arthritis - Resources

Information and support resources for arthritis, including diagnosis, pain management, exercise, medicines, joint protection, and rehabilitation.

## Artificial Urinary Sphincter

An implanted device that restores urinary continence by allowing controlled compression and release of the urethra. It is used mainly for selected cases of stress urinary incontinence and requires surgical placement and follow-up.

## Aspartate Aminotransferase (AST) Blood Test

A laboratory test that measures aspartate aminotransferase or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## Aspartic Acid

A nonessential amino acid incorporated into proteins and involved in the urea cycle, nucleotide synthesis, and other metabolic pathways. It is not the same as aspartame, an artificial sweetener that contains aspartic acid.

## Aspergillosis Precipitin

An antibody test that may support evaluation of exposure or immune response to *Aspergillus*; results must be interpreted with symptoms, imaging, and other tests.

## Asphalt Cement Poisoning

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Asphalt cement poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Aspirin And Heart Disease

Aspirin inhibits platelet aggregation and may prevent recurrent cardiovascular events in selected patients; routine primary prevention requires individualized assessment of benefit and bleeding risk.

## Aspirin Overdose

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Aspirin. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Assisted Delivery With Forceps

A procedure or perioperative-care topic involving assisted Delivery With Forceps; indications, preparation, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific procedure and patient.

## Asthma - Child - Discharge

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after asthma - child. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.



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## **Asthma - Control Drugs**

Long-term asthma medicines, especially inhaled corticosteroids, reduce airway inflammation and prevent exacerbations; they do not replace a rapid-relief medicine for acute symptoms.

## **Asthma - Quick-Relief Drugs**

Rapid-relief asthma medicines, commonly inhaled short-acting beta-2 agonists, relax bronchial smooth muscle for prompt symptom relief; frequent use signals inadequate control.

## **Asthma And Allergy Resources**

Information and support resources for asthma and allergic disease, including trigger avoidance, medicines, action plans, and emergency warning signs.

## **Asthma And School**

School-based asthma care includes an action plan, access to prescribed rescue medicine, trigger reduction, and staff training to recognize worsening breathing.

## **Asthma In Adults - What To Ask The Doctor**

A patient discussion topic about asthma, including symptom control, medicines, inhaler technique, action plans, and follow-up.

## **Asthma In Children**

A chronic inflammatory airway disorder in children causing variable wheeze, cough, chest tightness, and shortness of breath; diagnosis and treatment are guided by age-appropriate history and testing.

## **Asthma In Children - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient discussion topic about asthma, including symptom control, medicines, inhaler technique, action plans, and follow-up.

## **Asymptomatic Bacteriuria**

Bacteria detected in urine without urinary symptoms; treatment is selective, such as during preg-

nancy or before certain urologic procedures.

## **Asymptomatic HIV Infection**

HIV infection without current symptoms; ongoing viral replication can damage immunity, so diagnosis, monitoring, and antiretroviral treatment remain important.

## **Atopic Dermatitis - Children - Homecare**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after atopic dermatitis - children. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

## **Atopic Dermatitis - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after atopic dermatitis. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

## **Atrial Fibrillation - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning recovery or symptom management after atrial fibrillation. Appropriate care depends on the diagnosis, treatment, symptoms, warning signs, and follow-up plan.

## **Atrial Fibrillation And Atrial Flutter**

Atrial fibrillation produces chaotic atrial activity, while atrial flutter produces a rapid organized circuit; both can cause palpitations and increase stroke risk.

## **Atrial Myxoma**

A usually benign primary heart tumor, most often in the left atrium, that may obstruct blood flow or produce emboli and constitutional symptoms.

## **Aural Polyps**

Abnormal tissue projections in the ear canal or middle ear, often associated with chronic infection, inflammation, or cholesteatoma and requiring otologic evaluation.

## **Autism - Resources**

Information and support resources for autism, in-

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cluding diagnosis, developmental services, education, communication support, and caregiver resources.

### **Autism Spectrum Disorder - Asperger Syndrome**

A former diagnostic label for autism spectrum disorder in a person without intellectual disability or clinically significant early language delay. Current diagnostic systems classify this presentation under autism spectrum disorder rather than as a separate disorder.

### **Autism Spectrum Disorder - Childhood Disintegrative Disorder**

Childhood disintegrative disorder, also called Heller syndrome, is a rare condition involving marked loss of previously acquired language, social, and adaptive skills after apparently typical early development. Modern classifications place it within autism spectrum disorder, and evaluation should exclude other neurologic causes.

### **Autoerythrocyte Sensitivity**

A rare syndrome of painful bruising or purpura attributed to an abnormal reaction to a person's own red-cell components. The diagnosis is one of exclusion after bleeding disorders, medication effects, and other causes of bruising are assessed.

### **Autoimmune Diseases**

Autoimmune diseases arise when immune responses target the body's own tissues, producing organ-specific or systemic inflammation and damage.

### **Autoimmune Liver Disease Panel**

A laboratory test that measures autoimmune liver disease panel or related markers in blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Autoinflammatory Diseases**

Disorders of innate immune regulation that cause recurrent or persistent inflammation without the disease-specific autoantibodies typical of autoimmune disorders. They may cause fever, rash, joint inflammation, or organ damage and can be inherited

or acquired.

### **Autoinoculation**

Transfer of an infectious agent from one body site to another on the same person, often by touching or scratching.

### **Automatic Dishwasher Soap Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to Automatic dishwasher soap poisoning. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Autosomal Dominant**

Autosomal dominant inheritance occurs when one altered copy of a gene can produce a trait or disorder; an affected heterozygous parent may transmit it to about half of offspring.

### **Autosomal Dominant Tubulointerstitial Kidney Disease**

An inherited kidney disorder caused by pathogenic variants in genes such as UMOD, REN, or MUC1. It causes progressive loss of kidney function with relatively bland urine findings; some subtypes cause early gout or anemia.

### **Autosomal Recessive**

Autosomal recessive inheritance generally requires pathogenic variants in both copies of a gene; unaffected carrier parents can have an affected child.

### **Axillary Nerve Dysfunction**

Impairment of the axillary nerve, often from shoulder trauma, dislocation, compression, or surgery. It can cause weakness of shoulder abduction, deltoid wasting, and numbness over the lateral shoulder.

### **A Hemophilia (Hemophilia)**

Alternate index label for Hemophilia.

### **AA (Alopecia Areata)**

Alternate index label for Alopecia Areata.

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### **AAA (Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm)**

Alternate index label for Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm.

### **Abbreviations Medical Terms (Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms)**

Alternate index label for Common Medical Abbreviations and Terms.

### **Abdominal Pain (Causes, Remedies, Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Causes, Remedies, Treatment.

### **Abnormal Heart Rhythms (Heart Rhythm Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Heart Rhythm Disorders.

### **Abortion Spontaneous (Miscarriage Causes And Symptoms)**

Alternate index label for Miscarriage Causes and Symptoms.

### **Abscessed Tooth Guide**

An abscessed tooth contains a localized collection of pus caused by bacterial infection, usually from decay, a crack, or gum disease. Dental drainage, root-canal treatment, or extraction may be needed; fever, facial swelling, or difficulty swallowing requires urgent care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tooth Infected (Abscessed Tooth Guide)

### **Abscesses Skin (Boils)**

Alternate index label for Boils.

### **Abuse Child (Child Abuse Facts)**

Alternate index label for Child Abuse Facts.

### **Abuse Steroid (Anabolic Steroid Abuse)**

Alternate index label for Anabolic Steroid Abuse.

### **ACA (Affordable Care Act (ACA Or ObamaCare))**

Alternate index label for Affordable Care Act (ACA

or ObamaCare).

### **Aches, Pain, Fever**

Aches, pain, and fever are common symptoms of infection, inflammation, injury, medication effects, or other illness. The pattern, duration, associated symptoms, and temperature help determine whether evaluation or urgent treatment is needed.

### **Achondroplasia Vs Pseudoachondroplasia Differences**

Achondroplasia is a common skeletal dysplasia caused by altered FGFR3 signaling, whereas pseudoachondroplasia is usually caused by COMP or related cartilage-matrix variants. Both cause disproportionate short stature, but their spine, joint, radiographic, and inheritance features differ.

### **Acid Reflux (Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD))**

Alternate index label for Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD).

### **Acid Reflux (GERD In Infants And Children)**

Alternate index label for GERD in Infants and Children.

### **Acid Reflux Vs. Heartburn (Heartburn Vs. Acid Reflux Differences Similarities)**

Alternate index label for Heartburn vs. Acid Reflux Differences Similarities.

### **Acne Rosacea (Rosacea)**

Alternate index label for Rosacea.

### **Acquired Generalized And Inherited Lipodystrophy**

Lipodystrophy is abnormal loss or absence of adipose tissue. Acquired generalized forms develop after an immune or other trigger, while inherited forms result from gene variants; both can cause severe insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, and fatty liver.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Lipodystrophy (Acquired Generalized And Inherited Lipodystrophy)

### **Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS)**

Alternate index label for AIDS.

### **Acrochordon (Skin Tag)**

Alternate index label for Skin Tag.

### **Actinic Purpura Vs Senile Purpura**

Actinic or senile purpura consists of painless purple bruises on sun-damaged, thin skin, especially on the hands and forearms. It reflects fragile dermal vessels and connective tissue rather than a dangerous bleeding disorder, although widespread or unexplained bruising needs assessment.

### **Acute And Chronic Bursitis**

Bursitis is inflammation of a fluid-filled bursa that cushions a joint. Acute bursitis may follow trauma, infection, or sudden overuse; chronic bursitis reflects repeated pressure or inflammatory disease and causes localized pain, swelling, and tenderness with movement.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bursa Inflammation (Acute And Chronic Bursitis)

### **Acute Bronchitis (Bronchitis (Acute))**

Alternate index label for Bronchitis (Acute).

### **Addiction Sexual (Sexual Addiction)**

Alternate index label for Sexual Addiction.

### **Addisons Anemia (Pernicious Anemia)**

Alternate index label for Pernicious Anemia.

### **Addison's Disease How Treated And Can It Be Cured**

Addison disease is primary adrenal insufficiency, in which the adrenal glands do not produce enough cortisol and often aldosterone. Lifelong hormone replacement usually controls it; stress dosing and emergency injectable steroid plans help prevent adrenal crisis.

### **Adenoids And Tonsils**

The adenoids and tonsils are lymphoid tissues in the upper airway that participate in immune surveillance. Enlargement or recurrent infection can cause mouth breathing, snoring, sleep apnea, swallowing problems, or recurrent throat disease and may require medical or surgical evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tonsil Inflammation (Adenoids And Tonsils)

### **ADHD In Teens (Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder In Teens)**

Alternate index label for Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder in Teens.

### **Adhesive Capsulitis Of Shoulder (Frozen Shoulder)**

Alternate index label for Frozen Shoulder.

### **Adult ADHD**

Adult attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder is a persistent pattern of inattention, impulsivity, and hyperactivity that begins in childhood and impairs work, relationships, or daily organization. Diagnosis uses developmental history and symptom assessment; treatment may combine skills-based therapy and medication.

#### **Synonyms:**

Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (Adult ADHD)

### **Adult-Onset Asthma**

Adult-onset asthma is variable airway inflammation and narrowing that begins in adulthood, producing episodic wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or shortness of breath. Diagnosis uses symptoms and lung-function testing, and treatment reduces triggers and airway inflammation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Asthma Adult-Onset (Adult-Onset Asthma)

### **Adults Autism (Autism And Communication)**

Alternate index label for Autism and Communication.

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## **Adults Jaundice (Jaundice In Adults)**

Alternate index label for Jaundice in Adults.

## **Advance Directives (Advance Medical Directives)**

Alternate index label for Advance Medical Directives.

## **Advance Medical Directives**

Advance medical directives record a person's preferences for future medical care and identify a health-care proxy when the person cannot decide. They may address resuscitation, life support, artificial nutrition, and other treatments, and should be reviewed as circumstances change.

### **Synonyms:**

Advance Directives (Advance Medical Directives)

## **Advantages And Disadvantages Of A Hospital Birth**

A hospital birth provides immediate access to obstetric, anesthesia, newborn, and surgical services, which can be important when complications arise. Tradeoffs may include more routine interventions, less control over setting, and separation or transfer policies that vary by facility.

## **Advantages And Disadvantages Of Hysterectomy**

Hysterectomy removes the uterus and permanently ends pregnancy and menstruation. It can treat cancer, fibroids, severe bleeding, prolapse, or pain, but involves operative risks, recovery time, and possible effects on ovarian function or pelvic organs depending on the procedure.

## **AF (Atrial Fibrillation)**

Alternate index label for Atrial Fibrillation.

## **Affordable Care Act (ACA Or ObamaCare)**

Alternate index label for ACA or ObamaCare.

## **Afib (Atrial Fibrillation (AFib) Warning**

## **Symptoms)**

Alternate index label for Atrial Fibrillation (AFib) Warning Symptoms.

## **Afib (Atrial Fibrillation)**

Alternate index label for Atrial Fibrillation.

## **AFib Vs VFib Symptoms (Atrial Fibrillation Vs. Ventricular Fibrillation)**

Alternate index label for Atrial Fibrillation vs. Ventricular Fibrillation.

## **After A Positive Ovulation Test Are You Fertile?**

A positive ovulation test detects a rise in luteinizing hormone that usually precedes ovulation by about one to two days. Fertility is highest around this interval, but timing varies and the test does not confirm that an egg was released.

## **After Endolymphatic Sac Decompression Surgery**

After endolymphatic sac decompression, follow-up focuses on wound healing, vertigo, hearing, balance, and recurrence of inner-ear symptoms. Activity and ear-care instructions depend on the operation, and persistent severe vertigo, drainage, fever, or facial weakness needs prompt review.

## **Age Related Macular Degeneration (Macular Degeneration)**

Alternate index label for Macular Degeneration.

## **AIDS Vs. HIV (HIV Vs AIDS)**

Alternate index label for HIV vs AIDS.

## **Alcohol Abuse And Alcoholism**

Alcohol use disorder is a medical condition involving impaired control over drinking despite harm, craving, tolerance, or withdrawal. Treatment can include medically supervised withdrawal, counseling, peer support, and medications that reduce drinking or relapse risk.

### **Synonyms:**

Alcohol Dependence (Alcohol Abuse And Alco-

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holism)

### **Alcohol And Teens**

Alcohol exposure during adolescence can impair judgment, increase injury and unsafe-sex risk, and affect developing brain systems involved in learning and impulse control. Early screening, supportive communication, treatment of coexisting mental-health problems, and limiting access reduce harm.

### **Alcohol Dependence (Alcohol Abuse And Alcoholism)**

Alternate index label for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism.

### **Alcohol Pregnancy (Fetal Alcohol Syndrome (FAS))**

Alternate index label for Fetal Alcohol Syndrome (FAS).

### **Allergic Cascade**

The allergic cascade is the sequence in which an allergen activates immune cells, including IgE-bearing mast cells, causing release of histamine and other mediators. This produces symptoms such as itching, swelling, mucus, wheezing, hives, or anaphylaxis.

### **Allergies (Allergy)**

Alternate index label for Allergy.

### **Allergy**

An allergy is an inappropriate immune response to a normally harmless substance such as pollen, food, medicine, insect venom, or animal proteins. Symptoms range from localized rhinitis or hives to life-threatening anaphylaxis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Allergies (Allergy)

### **Allergy Diaper (Intertrigo)**

Alternate index label for Intertrigo.

### **Allergy Eczema (Atopic Dermatitis)**

Alternate index label for Atopic Dermatitis.

### **Allergy Eye (Eye Allergy)**

Alternate index label for Eye Allergy.

### **Allergy Food (Food Allergy)**

Alternate index label for Food Allergy.

### **Allergy Home Remedies (Allergy Treatment Begins At Home)**

Alternate index label for Allergy Treatment Begins At Home.

### **Allergy Insect (Insect Sting Allergies)**

Alternate index label for Insect Sting Allergies.

### **Allergy Latex (Latex Allergy)**

Alternate index label for Latex Allergy.

### **Allergy Plant Contact (Poison Ivy, Oak, And Sumac)**

Alternate index label for Poison Ivy, Oak, and Sumac.

### **Allergy Rash (Rash)**

Alternate index label for Rash.

### **Allergy Treatment Begins At Home**

Home allergy care may include reducing exposure to the trigger, improving indoor air filtration, washing after outdoor exposure, saline nasal rinsing with safe water, and using recommended medicines correctly. Breathing difficulty, throat swelling, faintness, or widespread symptoms require emergency care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Allergy Home Remedies (Allergy Treatment Begins At Home)

### **Alopecia (Hair Loss)**

Alternate index label for Hair Loss.

### **ALS Vs. MS (ALS Vs. MS Differences And Similarities)**

Alternate index label for ALS vs. MS Differences and Similarities.



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## ALS Vs. MS Differences And Similarities

Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis primarily destroys motor neurons and causes progressive weakness, while multiple sclerosis causes immune-mediated lesions in the brain and spinal cord with varied sensory, visual, motor, or cognitive symptoms. Examination, imaging, laboratory testing, and time course distinguish them.

## Alternative Therapy For Multiple Sclerosis

Complementary approaches for multiple sclerosis may support symptoms such as fatigue, pain, stress, or mobility but do not replace disease-modifying treatment. Exercise, rehabilitation, mindfulness, and selected supplements should be discussed with clinicians because interactions and unproven claims are common.

### Synonyms:

MS Alternative And Complementary Therapies (Alternative Therapy For Multiple Sclerosis)

## Alternative Treatments For Hot Flashes

Nonhormonal approaches to hot flashes include cooling strategies, layered clothing, sleep and stress measures, cognitive behavioral therapy, and selected prescription medicines. Herbal products have variable evidence and can interact with medicines; treatment choice depends on symptoms and medical history.

## Alveolar Osteitis (Dry Socket Overview)

Alternate index label for Dry Socket Overview.

## Alzheimer's Disease Causes, Stages, And Symptoms

Alzheimer disease is a progressive neurodegenerative disorder causing decline in memory and other thinking abilities, followed by increasing difficulty with communication, judgment, movement, and self-care. Progression varies, and evaluation looks for reversible contributors and other dementias.

## Alzheimer's Disease Symptoms And Stages

Alzheimer disease commonly progresses from subtle memory and planning problems to loss of indepen-

dence, language and recognition difficulties, and eventually extensive assistance needs. Symptoms and speed of progression differ, so staging supports care planning rather than predicting an exact timeline.

### Synonyms:

Alzheimers Disease Stages And Symptoms (Alzheimer's Disease Symptoms And Stages)

## Alzheimers Disease Stages And Symptoms (Alzheimer's Disease Symptoms And Stages)

Alternate index label for Alzheimer's Disease Symptoms and Stages.

## Am I Depressed

Depression is more than temporary sadness: it involves persistent low mood or loss of interest with changes in sleep, appetite, energy, concentration, movement, self-worth, or hope. Thoughts of self-harm require immediate emergency or crisis support.

## Amblyopia Lazy Eye

Amblyopia is reduced vision in an eye that did not develop normal visual processing during childhood, often because of unequal focusing power, misalignment, or obstruction. Early treatment may include glasses, patching or blurring the stronger eye, and correction of the underlying problem.

## Amebiasis Entamoeba Histolytica Infection

Amebiasis is infection with *Entamoeba histolytica*, acquired through fecally contaminated food, water, or hands. It may cause diarrhea or dysentery and can spread to the liver; stool testing and appropriate tissue-active and luminal treatment are used.

### Synonyms:

Amoebic Dysentery (Amebiasis Entamoeba Histolytica Infection)

## Amoebic Dysentery (Amebiasis Entamoeba Histolytica Infection)

Alternate index label for Amebiasis Entamoeba histolytica Infection.

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## **Amyloid Disease (Amyloidosis)**

Alternate index label for Amyloidosis.

## **Anabolic Steroid Abuse**

Anabolic-androgenic steroid misuse can cause infertility, testicular shrinkage, acne, mood changes, high blood pressure, adverse cholesterol changes, liver injury, and cardiovascular events. Stopping may produce withdrawal symptoms and is safest with medical support.

### **Synonyms:**

Abuse Steroid (Anabolic Steroid Abuse)

## **Anal Ulcer (Anal Fissure)**

Alternate index label for Anal Fissure.

## **Anemia How Is It Treated And Can It Be Cured**

Anemia is reduced oxygen-carrying capacity from low red-cell number or hemoglobin. Treatment depends on cause, such as iron or vitamin deficiency, blood loss, kidney disease, inflammation, or inherited disease; correcting the cause may resolve it, while some conditions require long-term management.

## **Aneurysm Vs Stroke (Stroke Vs Aneurysm Differences And Similarities)**

Alternate index label for Stroke vs Aneurysm Differences and Similarities.

## **Aneurysm Vs Stroke Which Is Worse**

An aneurysm is a weakened, bulging blood-vessel wall, whereas a stroke is brain injury from interrupted blood flow or bleeding. A ruptured brain aneurysm can cause a hemorrhagic stroke, and the seriousness of either condition depends on location, size, bleeding, and neurologic injury.

## **Angiitis (Vasculitis)**

Alternate index label for Vasculitis.

## **Angina Symptoms**

Angina is chest discomfort caused by inadequate blood flow to heart muscle, commonly from coronary

artery disease. Pressure or squeezing may spread to the arm, jaw, back, or shoulder and can occur with exertion; new, severe, or resting symptoms require emergency assessment.

### **Synonyms:**

Ischemic Chest Pain (Angina Symptoms)

## **Angioedema (Hives)**

Alternate index label for Hives.

## **Angioedema Hereditary (Hereditary Angioedema HAE)**

Alternate index label for Hereditary Angioedema HAE.

## **Ankle Dislocated (Dislocated Ankle (Ankle Dislocation))**

Alternate index label for Dislocated Ankle (Ankle Dislocation).

## **Ankle Pain And Tendinitis**

Ankle pain may result from sprain, fracture, arthritis, tendon inflammation, nerve disease, infection, or referred pain. Tendinitis causes pain along an affected tendon and often worsens with loading; swelling, deformity, inability to bear weight, fever, or numbness warrants evaluation.

## **Ankle Swollen (Swollen Ankles And Swollen Feet)**

Alternate index label for Swollen Ankles and Swollen Feet.

## **Antidiabetics-Oral**

Oral antidiabetic medicines lower blood glucose through different mechanisms, including increasing insulin release, improving insulin sensitivity, reducing hepatic glucose production, or increasing urinary glucose loss. Selection considers kidney function, hypoglycemia risk, weight, cardiovascular disease, and cost.

### **Synonyms:**

Medications Type 2 Diabetes (Antidiabetics-Oral)

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## Antiemetics

Antiemetics are medicines used to prevent or treat nausea and vomiting. Drug classes act on serotonin, dopamine, histamine, acetylcholine, or neurokinin pathways; choice depends on the cause, age, pregnancy, other medicines, heart rhythm risk, and hydration status.

## Anxiety Separation (Separation Anxiety)

Separation anxiety is excessive fear or distress when separated from an attachment figure, beyond what is expected for developmental stage. It can cause avoidance, physical complaints, sleep difficulty, and school impairment and is treated with behavioral therapy and, when needed, medication.

## Apnea Sleep (Sleep Apnea)

Sleep apnea consists of repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep. Obstructive apnea results from upper-airway collapse, while central apnea reflects reduced respiratory drive; untreated disease can cause daytime sleepiness, impaired concentration, hypertension, and cardiovascular risk.

## APS (Antiphospholipid Syndrome)

Alternate index label for Antiphospholipid Syndrome.

## Are Antiperspirants Harmful

Antiperspirants reduce sweating, usually with aluminum salts, and are generally safe when used on intact skin as directed. Irritation or contact dermatitis can occur; persistent excessive sweating, a new generalized change, or symptoms of illness deserves medical evaluation.

## Are Bananas Bad For Kidneys?

Bananas are not universally harmful to the kidneys, but they contain potassium. People with advanced kidney disease or medicines that raise potassium may need individualized portions and laboratory monitoring rather than making dietary changes without clinical advice.

## Are Bananas Bad If You Are Trying To

## Lose Weight?

Bananas can fit a weight-loss eating pattern because they provide carbohydrate, fiber, and nutrients, but portion size and total energy intake determine weight change. Pairing fruit with a balanced meal or protein may improve satiety.

## Are Bananas Fattening For You?

Bananas are not inherently fattening; body weight changes when average energy intake exceeds expenditure. They contain natural carbohydrate and calories, so serving size matters, especially in calorie-restricted diets or diabetes meal planning.

## Are Bananas Good For Diabetes

People with diabetes can often include bananas in portions that fit their carbohydrate plan. Ripeness, serving size, total meal composition, glucose-lowering treatment, and individual glucose response influence their effect on blood sugar.

## Are Bean Sprouts Good For You

Bean sprouts provide fiber and micronutrients but can harbor *Salmonella*, *E. coli*, or other pathogens because they grow in warm, moist conditions. Cooking sprouts thoroughly lowers infection risk, especially for pregnant people, children, older adults, and immunocompromised people.

## Are Bedbugs Contagious

Bedbugs do not spread from person to person like an infection, but they can travel in clothing, luggage, bedding, and furniture. Bites cause itchy skin reactions in some people; control requires treating the environment rather than treating the person for contagion.

### Synonyms:

Bedbugs Contagious (Are Bedbugs Contagious)

## Are Belly Bands Safe During Pregnancy

A pregnancy belly band may temporarily support the abdomen or reduce pelvic and back discomfort when properly fitted. It should not be tight enough to impair breathing, circulation, digestion, or fetal movement, and persistent pain or swelling needs obstetric evaluation.

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### **Are Blood Clots Normal In Early Pregnancy**

Small clots or spotting in early pregnancy are not automatically normal and can occur with benign cervical changes, miscarriage, or ectopic pregnancy. Heavy bleeding, one-sided pain, shoulder pain, dizziness, or fainting requires urgent assessment.

### **Are Breast Implants Worth It?**

Whether breast implants are worthwhile depends on goals, expected appearance, health, cost, and willingness to accept revision surgery and implant-related risks. Complications include capsular contracture, rupture, infection, changes in sensation, and rare implant-associated malignancy.

### **Are C-Sections Really That Bad**

Cesarean delivery can be lifesaving and appropriate, but it is major abdominal surgery with risks such as infection, bleeding, blood clots, organ injury, and longer recovery. It can also affect risks in later pregnancies; decisions depend on maternal and fetal circumstances.

### **Are Canker Sores Contagious**

Canker sores are shallow ulcers inside the mouth and are not contagious. They may be associated with minor trauma, stress, nutritional deficiency, immune disease, or other triggers; unusually large, frequent, persistent, or systemic-associated ulcers need evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Contagious Canker Sores (Are Canker Sores Contagious) Sores Canker Contagious (Are Canker Sores Contagious)

### **Are Carrots Healthy For Babies?**

Carrots can provide fiber and beta-carotene for babies when introduced in an age-appropriate, soft form. Choking risk depends on texture and shape, so whole raw pieces are unsafe for young children; introduce foods according to developmental readiness.

### **Are Collagen Supplements Good For**

### **You?**

Collagen supplements provide amino-acid peptides that may modestly affect skin elasticity or joint symptoms in some studies, but evidence and product quality vary. They do not replace adequate dietary protein, and allergies, contaminants, cost, and medicine interactions should be considered.

### **Are Contact Lenses Better Than Glasses?**

Contact lenses provide a wider field of view and may be preferred for sports or appearance, while glasses are easier to maintain and avoid direct corneal infection risk. The better option depends on prescription, eye health, comfort, hygiene, and ability to follow care instructions.

### **Are Contact Lenses Safe?**

Contact lenses are generally safe with proper fitting, hand hygiene, cleaning, replacement, and wear time. Sleeping or swimming in lenses and using contaminated solutions raises the risk of microbial keratitis, which can threaten vision and requires urgent care for pain, redness, or light sensitivity.

### **Are CPAP Machines Worth It**

Continuous positive airway pressure can reduce obstructive sleep-apnea events, improve oxygenation and daytime alertness, and lower some health risks when used consistently. Benefit depends on correct diagnosis, mask fit, comfort, adherence, and follow-up adjustment.

### **Are Dental Implants Worth It**

Dental implants can restore chewing and support a crown, bridge, or denture after tooth loss. Success depends on bone, gums, smoking, diabetes control, oral hygiene, surgical risk, time, and cost; complications include infection, bone loss, nerve injury, and implant failure.

### **Are Dimples Rare?**

Facial dimples are common inherited variations caused by differences in the muscles or connective tissue beneath the skin. They are usually harmless and do not indicate a medical disorder.

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### **Are Earwigs Harmful To Humans**

Earwigs are not known to crawl into human ears as a normal behavior and are generally harmless. They can pinch defensively, but they do not have venom; a bite or pinch should be cleaned and observed for infection.

### **Are Eggs Bad For Pancreatitis**

Eggs are not automatically prohibited after pancreatitis, but tolerance depends on disease severity and dietary fat. During recovery, clinicians may recommend a gradual return to lower-fat meals; persistent pain, vomiting, or inability to eat needs medical review.

### **Are Eggs Good For An Upset Stomach**

Plain, well-cooked eggs may be tolerated during recovery from some stomach illnesses and provide protein, but they can worsen symptoms for people with particular food intolerance, reflux, gallbladder disease, or infection. Hydration and the underlying cause remain more important than one food.

### **Are Gastric Bypasses Reversible?**

Gastric bypass anatomy can sometimes be revised, but reversal is complex and not routine. It may be considered for serious complications or specific nutritional problems and carries operative risks; long-term dietary and supplement needs continue to require monitoring.

### **Are Ground-Glass Opacities Common**

Ground-glass opacity is a hazy area on chest CT in which vessels remain partly visible. It is a radiologic finding rather than a diagnosis and can reflect infection, inflammation, edema, hemorrhage, fibrosis, or early malignancy; interpretation depends on pattern and clinical context.

### **Are Heated Blankets Bad For You**

Heated blankets are generally safe when used according to instructions, but burns, overheating, fire, and electrical injury can occur. People with reduced sensation, limited mobility, or inability to respond to heat should use extra caution or avoid them.

### **Are Hiccups Good Or Bad**

Hiccups are involuntary diaphragm contractions that are usually brief and harmless. Persistent or recurrent hiccups can result from irritation, medication, metabolic disease, or nervous-system disorders and may interfere with eating, sleeping, or breathing.

### **Are Hives (Urticaria) Contagious**

Alternate index label for Urticaria) Contagious.

### **Are Hives And Rash The Same Thing**

Hives are a specific type of rash consisting of raised, itchy welts that usually move or fade within 24 hours. Other rashes may involve scales, blisters, bruising, or fixed lesions, so appearance and duration help identify the cause.

### **Are Katydid's Dangerous?**

Katydid's are generally harmless insects and do not normally attack people. Contact may cause a minor pinch or local irritation, but severe reactions are unusual; rapidly spreading swelling, breathing trouble, or systemic symptoms need emergency care.

### **Are Loofahs Bad For You?**

Loofahs can harbor bacteria and fungi when kept damp and may irritate or abrade skin. Rinse and dry them thoroughly, replace them regularly, and avoid sharing or using them on broken, infected, or freshly shaved skin.

### **Are Menstrual Cups Bad For You**

Menstrual cups are generally safe when correctly fitted, cleaned, and emptied on schedule. Possible problems include irritation, pain, leakage, difficult removal, and rare toxic shock syndrome; use during an intrauterine-device placement should be discussed with a clinician.

### **Are Pregnancy Pillows Good For Back Pain?**

Pregnancy pillows can support the abdomen, hips, or knees and may improve sleep-related back or pelvic discomfort. They do not treat serious causes of pain; weakness, numbness, fever, bleeding, con-



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tractions, or severe persistent pain needs obstetric advice.

### **Are Rubella And German Measles The Same Thing**

Rubella and German measles are the same viral infection. It is usually mild in children and adults but can cause miscarriage, fetal death, or congenital rubella syndrome when infection occurs during pregnancy; vaccination prevents it.

### **Are Shirataki Noodles Bad For You?**

Shirataki noodles contain glucomannan fiber and are generally safe in appropriate portions with adequate fluid. Large amounts may cause bloating, diarrhea, choking, or obstruction, and they can affect absorption of medicines if taken too close together.

### **Are Skin Rashes Contagious**

Some rashes spread through infection, while others result from allergy, irritation, inflammation, medication, or internal disease and are not contagious. Fever, rapid spread, mucosal involvement, severe pain, blistering, or breathing symptoms warrants prompt evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Skin Rashes Contagious (Are Skin Rashes Contagious)

### **Are Smelly Farts Healthy? Types Of Farts**

Intestinal gas and odor are normal results of swallowed air and bacterial fermentation of food. A sudden persistent change with weight loss, bleeding, severe pain, vomiting, fever, or altered bowel habits can indicate gastrointestinal disease.

### **Are Strawberries Good For Your Stomach?**

Strawberries provide fiber and vitamin C and are tolerated by many people. Their acidity, seeds, or fermentable carbohydrates can aggravate reflux, allergy, or bowel symptoms in some individuals, so response and portion size matter.

### **Are Warts Caused By Being Dirty**

Warts are caused by infection with human papillomavirus, not by being dirty. The virus enters small breaks in skin and spreads through contact or shared surfaces; hygiene can reduce spread but does not imply blame.

### **Are Warts Contagious?**

Warts can spread through direct contact, shared items, or self-inoculation from one body site to another. Avoid picking them, keep them covered when appropriate, and do not share towels, nail tools, or footwear.

### **Are Widow's Peaks Attractive**

A widow's peak is a V-shaped hairline variant with no established medical significance. Its appearance is a normal trait and does not reliably indicate personality, health, or genetic disease.

### **Are You Too Sick To Work**

Whether illness warrants staying home depends on symptoms, contagiousness, ability to function safely, job demands, and workplace policy. Fever, vomiting, significant diarrhea, uncontrolled respiratory symptoms, or a positive contagious-infection test commonly support staying home and seeking advice.

### **Arrest Cardiac (Sudden Cardiac Death)**

Alternate index label for Sudden Cardiac Death.

### **Arsenic Poisoning**

Arsenic poisoning results from acute or chronic exposure to inorganic or organic arsenic. It can cause gastrointestinal illness, cardiovascular instability, neuropathy, characteristic skin changes, anemia, and increased cancer risk; suspected exposure requires poison-control or emergency guidance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Poisoning Arsenic (Arsenic Poisoning)

### **Arthritis Ankylosing Spondylitis (Ankylosing Spondylitis)**

Alternate index label for Ankylosing Spondylitis.



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### **Arthritis Degenerative (Osteoarthritis)**

Alternate index label for Osteoarthritis.

### **Arthritis Gout (Gout (Gouty Arthritis))**

Alternate index label for Gout (Gouty Arthritis).

### **Arthritis Infectious (Septic Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Septic Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Juvenile (Juvenile Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Juvenile Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Lyme (Lyme Disease)**

Alternate index label for Lyme Disease.

### **Arthritis MCTD (Mixed Connective Tissue Disease)**

Alternate index label for Mixed Connective Tissue Disease.

### **Arthritis Plant Thorn (Plant Thorn Synovitis)**

Alternate index label for Plant Thorn Synovitis.

### **Arthritis Pseudogout (Pseudogout)**

Alternate index label for Pseudogout.

### **Arthritis Psoriatic (Psoriatic Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Psoriatic Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Quackery (Quackery Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Quackery Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Reactive (Reactive Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Reactive Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Reiters (Reactive Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Reactive Arthritis.

### **Arthritis Sarcoid (Sarcoidosis)**

Alternate index label for Sarcoidosis.

### **Arthritis Scleroderma (Scleroderma)**

Alternate index label for Scleroderma.

### **Arthritis Sjogrens Syndrome (Sjogren's Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Sjogren's Syndrome.

### **Arthritis SLE (Systemic Lupus)**

Alternate index label for Systemic Lupus.

### **Arthritis Still (Still's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Still's Disease.

### **Asbestos-Related Disorders**

Asbestos exposure can cause pleural plaques, diffuse pleural thickening, asbestosis, lung cancer, and mesothelioma after a long latency. Risk increases with cumulative exposure and smoking, and evaluation may include occupational history, imaging, and lung-function testing.

### **Aspergillus Infection (Aspergillosis)**

Alternate index label for Aspergillosis.

### **Asthma Adult-Onset (Adult-Onset Asthma)**

Alternate index label for Adult-Onset Asthma.

### **Asthma Complexities**

Asthma varies in trigger, severity, airway inflammation, and response to treatment. Difficult-to-control symptoms may reflect poor inhaler technique, ongoing exposure, incorrect diagnosis, comorbid disease, or severe asthma requiring specialist assessment.

### **Asthma Medications**

Asthma medicines include controller treatments that reduce airway inflammation and reliever treatments that quickly relax airway muscle. The regimen is guided by symptom frequency, lung function, exacerbation risk, age, pregnancy, technique, and response.

### **Asthma OTC Medication (Asthma: Over The Counter Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Asthma: Over The Counter Treatment.

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## **Asthma Overview**

Asthma is a chronic disorder of variable airway inflammation and narrowing that causes wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or breathlessness. Symptoms fluctuate with triggers, and management combines an individualized action plan, inhaled medicines, trigger reduction, and monitoring.

### **Synonyms:**

Bronchial Asthma (Asthma Overview)

## **Asthma Vs. COPD (COPD Vs. Asthma Differences And Similarities)**

Alternate index label for COPD vs. Asthma Differences and Similarities.

## **Asthma: Over The Counter Treatment**

Over-the-counter products do not replace prescription asthma evaluation or a rescue plan. Some may temporarily relieve symptoms but can delay treatment of dangerous airway obstruction; worsening breathlessness, difficulty speaking, cyanosis, or poor response to a reliever is an emergency.

### **Synonyms:**

Asthma OTC Medication (Asthma: Over The Counter Treatment)

## **Astigmatism Overview**

Astigmatism is an irregular curvature of the cornea or lens that prevents light from focusing at one retinal point. It can cause blurred or distorted vision, eyestrain, and headaches and is corrected with glasses, contact lenses, or selected procedures.

## **At What Age Do Late Talkers Talk**

Late talking varies widely, but a child with delayed words, gestures, understanding, or social communication should be assessed rather than watched indefinitely. Hearing testing and developmental evaluation can identify language disorder, autism, hearing loss, or other causes and support early therapy.

## **At What Age Does Gender Identity Develop**

Gender identity is a person's internal sense of gender and develops through a combination of biological,

developmental, and social factors. Children may express a gender identity early, and supportive, non-judgmental care is appropriate regardless of whether identity changes over time.

## **At What Age Is A Parent Not Legally Responsible**

Legal responsibility for a child varies by jurisdiction, age, custody arrangement, and circumstances such as disability or emancipation. Medical consent and financial responsibility may follow different rules, so local legal or social-service advice is needed for a specific case.

## **At What Age Is Co-Sleeping Safe With Your Baby**

The safest sleep arrangement for an infant is a separate, firm, flat sleep surface in the same room as a caregiver, without pillows, loose bedding, or soft objects. Bed-sharing carries increased suffocation and sleep-related death risk, especially for young infants and when adults smoke, drink, or use sedating drugs.

## **At What Age Should You Stop Birth Control?**

Birth control is usually continued until pregnancy is no longer possible, which is commonly around menopause but varies by method and health history. Stopping requires a plan for pregnancy prevention or conception and review of bleeding, migraine, clot, cancer, and medication risks.

## **At What Stage Is CLL Treated?**

Chronic lymphocytic leukemia is often observed when it is asymptomatic and stable. Treatment is generally started for progressive anemia or thrombocytopenia, enlarging disease, significant symptoms, rapid progression, or complications, using blood counts, examination, genetics, and symptoms to guide timing.

## **At What Stage Of Cancer Is Chemotherapy Used**

Chemotherapy may be used before surgery or radiation, after local treatment, as the main treatment for

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disseminated disease, or for symptom control. The stage and regimen depend on cancer type, molecular features, treatment goals, organ function, and patient preferences.

### **Athletes Foot (Athlete's Foot)**

Alternate index label for Athlete's Foot.

### **Atopic Dermatitis Vs Contact Dermatitis**

Atopic dermatitis is a chronic eczema associated with skin-barrier dysfunction and an atopic tendency, while contact dermatitis follows exposure to an irritant or allergen. Distribution, exposure history, recurrence, and patch testing can help distinguish them; both require skin protection and targeted treatment.

### **Atopic Dermatitis Vs Psoriasis**

Atopic dermatitis commonly causes intensely itchy, poorly defined eczema in flexural areas, while psoriasis produces well-demarcated thicker plaques with silvery scale and may involve nails or extensor surfaces. Overlap occurs, so examination and history guide diagnosis.

### **Atrial Fibrillation (AFib) Warning Symptoms**

Alternate index label for AFib) Warning Symptom.

### **Atrial Fibrillation AFib Treatment Drugs**

Medicines for atrial fibrillation may slow the ventricular rate, restore or maintain rhythm, or reduce stroke risk with anticoagulation. Choice depends on symptoms, heart structure, kidney function, bleeding risk, other diseases, and whether rhythm control is appropriate.

### **Atrial Fibrillation Vs. Atrial Flutter (Atrial Flutter Vs. Atrial Fibrillation)**

Alternate index label for Atrial Flutter vs. Atrial Fibrillation.

### **Atrial Fibrillation Vs. Ventricular Fibrillation**

Atrial fibrillation is a rapid, irregular atrial rhythm

that may allow the ventricles to pump, whereas ventricular fibrillation is chaotic ventricular activity that stops effective circulation. Ventricular fibrillation causes cardiac arrest and requires immediate defibrillation and resuscitation.

### **Atrial Flutter Vs. Atrial Fibrillation**

Atrial flutter usually has a rapid organized atrial circuit with characteristic sawtooth activity, while atrial fibrillation has chaotic atrial activation and an irregular ventricular response. Both can cause palpitations and stroke risk and may require rate control, rhythm treatment, and anticoagulation.

### **Atrophy Vaginal (Vaginal Dryness And Vaginal Atrophy)**

Alternate index label for Vaginal Dryness and Vaginal Atrophy.

### **Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (Adult ADHD)**

Alternate index label for Adult ADHD.

### **Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder In Teens**

ADHD in teenagers causes persistent inattention, impulsivity, or hyperactivity that interferes with school, relationships, driving, or organization. Assessment includes childhood history and screening for learning disorders, sleep problems, substance use, anxiety, depression, and other conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

ADHD In Teens (Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder In Teens)

### **Autism And Communication**

Autism can affect social communication, language development, nonverbal interaction, and the use of communication for shared attention or relationships. Individualized speech-language therapy, visual supports, augmentative communication, and respectful environmental accommodations can improve participation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Adults Autism (Autism And Communication) Children Autism (Autism And Communication)

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### **Autonomic Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Avascular Necrosis (Aseptic Necrosis)**

Alternate index label for Aseptic Necrosis.

### **Average Life Expectancy After A Liver Transplant?**

Life expectancy after liver transplantation varies with the original disease, recipient health, graft function, rejection, infection, cancer recurrence, and adherence to follow-up. Lifelong immunosuppression, surveillance, preventive care, and management of cardiovascular and metabolic risks are essential.

### **Avian Flu (Avian Influenza (Bird Flu))**

Avian influenza is infection with influenza A viruses adapted primarily to birds. Human infection is uncommon but can be severe after contact with infected birds or mammals; exposure history, respiratory symptoms, and public-health testing guide evaluation and treatment.

### **Avian Influenza (Bird Flu)**

Avian influenza is infection with influenza A viruses adapted primarily to birds. Human infection is uncommon but can be severe after contact with infected birds or mammals; exposure history, respiratory symptoms, and public-health testing guide evaluation and treatment.

### **A (Adenine)**

In genetics, A denotes adenine, a nucleobase that pairs with thymine in DNA and with uracil in RNA.

### **A-T**

A-T is the adenine–thymine base pair in DNA, formed by specific hydrogen bonding between the two complementary bases.

### **A.C.**

A prescription abbreviation meaning “before meals,” from the Latin ante cibum.

### **AAA**

Abdominal aortic aneurysm: an abnormal enlargement or ballooning of the abdominal aorta that can rupture and cause life-threatening internal bleeding.

### **AAAS**

The American Association for the Advancement of Science, a scientific organization that publishes the journal *Science* and supports research and science education.

### **AAD**

The American Academy of Dermatology, a professional organization representing dermatologists and advancing dermatologic care, education, and research.

### **AAO**

An abbreviation that may mean alert and oriented or refer to an ophthalmology, otolaryngology, or orthodontics professional organization; the clinical context determines the intended meaning.

### **AAP**

The American Academy of Pediatrics, a professional organization focused on the health and well-being of infants, children, adolescents, and young adults.

### **Aarskog-Scott Syndrome**

A rare inherited developmental disorder, often related to FGD1 variants, characterized by distinctive facial features, short stature, skeletal differences, and genital anomalies.

### **Aase-Smith Syndrome I**

A rare congenital-malformation syndrome associated with hydrocephalus, cleft palate, severe joint contractures, distinctive hand and facial findings, and sometimes heart defects.

### **Aase-Smith Syndrome II**

A rare inherited disorder characterized by hypoplastic anemia and triphalangeal thumbs, in which the thumbs contain three phalanges rather than the usual two.

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## **Ab-**

A medical prefix meaning away from, off, or separating from, as in abduction (movement away from the midline) and ablation (removal or destruction of tissue).

## **Abate**

To become less intense or to reduce in severity, frequency, or amount; symptoms, inflammation, pain, or fever may abate.

## **Abatement**

A reduction in the severity, intensity, frequency, or amount of a symptom, disease process, exposure, or other condition.

## **Abdomen, Acute**

Acute abdomen is sudden or severe abdominal pain with possible tenderness, guarding, vomiting, distention, or altered bowel function that may indicate a surgical or other urgent condition.

## **Abdominal**

Relating to the abdomen, the body region between the chest and pelvis that contains organs of the digestive, urinary, and reproductive systems.

## **Abdominal Guarding**

Involuntary or voluntary tensing of the abdominal muscles in response to palpation, often associated with irritation or inflammation of the peritoneum.

## **Abdominal Hysterectomy**

Surgical removal of the uterus through an incision in the abdominal wall; the cervix, ovaries, and fallopian tubes may or may not also be removed.

## **Abducent Nerve**

The sixth cranial nerve, also called the abducens nerve, which supplies the lateral rectus muscle and abducts the eye.

## **Abductor Muscle**

A muscle that moves a body part away from the midline or, for a digit, away from the axis of the

hand or foot.

## **Aberration**

A deviation from normal structure, function, or appearance; in optics, it is an imperfection that prevents light from forming a sharply focused image.

## **Abiotic**

Nonliving; in biology and medicine, the term describes physical or chemical environmental factors rather than living organisms.

## **Abiotrophy**

Progressive degeneration or loss of function in a tissue or organ, often due to an inherited or developmental defect rather than an acquired injury. The process may reflect a genetically determined failure of cellular maintenance, metabolism, or structural integrity. Clinical manifestations vary with the affected organ and can include progressive weakness, sensory loss, ataxia, or organ-specific dysfunction. Diagnosis is guided by the clinical course, examination, laboratory studies, imaging, and genetic or pathologic evaluation when indicated.

## **Ablate**

To remove or destroy tissue, usually by surgery, heat, cold, chemicals, or another energy source.

## **Abortive**

Incomplete, unsuccessful, or stopped before full development; an abortive infection produces limited disease without the usual complete clinical course.

## **Abortive Polio**

A mild, nonparalytic poliovirus infection causing nonspecific fever, sore throat, headache, nausea, or malaise without the neurologic findings of paralytic polio.

## **ABR Test**

Auditory brainstem response testing records electrical activity from the auditory nerve and brainstem through scalp electrodes to assess hearing and auditory-pathway function, especially in infants

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or people unable to provide reliable behavioral responses.

### **Abrade**

To wear away tissue by friction or erosion; an abrasion is the resulting scrape or superficial loss of skin.

### **Abs**

An informal term for the abdominal muscles, particularly the anterior abdominal-wall muscles.

### **Abscission**

Removal of tissue by cutting it away, as in a surgical procedure.

### **Absence Of The Breast**

Congenital absence of breast development, called amastia; it may affect one or both sides and can occur with other developmental anomalies.

### **Absence Of The Nipple**

Athelia: a rare congenital absence of one or both nipples, which may occur with hereditary disorders, chromosomal abnormalities, or developmental syndromes.

### **Absent Eye**

Anophthalmia, a congenital absence or severe underdevelopment of the eye globe and ocular tissue; it may affect one or both eyes and may occur with other birth defects.

### **Absinthism**

A historical disorder attributed to habitual absinthe abuse, associated with alcohol dependence and reported hallucinations, insomnia, tremor, and seizures; the specific contribution of absinthe constituents was uncertain.

### **Absorb**

To take in a substance, such as through the skin or intestine, or to reduce the intensity of radiation or light by taking up its energy.

### **Abstinence**

Deliberate avoidance of a substance or behavior, especially refraining from alcohol, drugs, tobacco, or sexual activity.

### **AC Joint**

The acromioclavicular joint, a gliding joint between the acromion of the scapula and the clavicle at the top of the shoulder.

### **Acanthamoeba**

A free-living amoeba found in soil and water that can cause keratitis, skin infection, or rarely granulomatous amoebic encephalitis, especially in people with impaired immunity.

### **Acaricide**

A pesticide or other agent used to kill mites and related arachnids such as ticks.

### **ACC**

Adenoid cystic carcinoma, a malignant tumor that most often arises in glandular tissues such as the salivary glands and may grow slowly but invade nerves or recur.

### **Access**

In health care, the opportunity to obtain care; in dialysis, vascular access is the site where a needle or catheter enters the bloodstream.

### **Accessory**

Additional or supplementary; in anatomy, an accessory structure is an extra part or a structure that assists the usual organ or system.

### **Accessory Digestive Organ**

An organ that supports digestion but is not part of the alimentary canal, such as the liver, pancreas, gallbladder, or salivary glands.

### **Accessory Dwelling Unit**

A secondary, independent residential unit on the same property as a primary home; it is a housing and community-health term rather than a disease



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or body structure.

### **Accessory Placenta**

An extra placental lobe separate from the main placenta but connected to it by fetal blood vessels; it can increase the risk of retained placental tissue or vessel injury during delivery.

### **Acellular**

Lacking cells; an acellular material may consist of extracellular matrix, mineral, fluid, or other components without intact living cells.

### **Acentric Chromosome**

A chromosome fragment that lacks a centromere and therefore usually cannot attach normally to the spindle during cell division.

### **Acetaminophen**

A non-opioid analgesic and antipyretic, also called paracetamol, used to relieve mild-to-moderate pain and reduce fever. It has little clinically useful anti-inflammatory activity. Excessive doses can cause severe, potentially fatal hepatic injury, especially with alcohol misuse, fasting, liver disease, or concurrent use of other acetaminophen-containing products; dosing must therefore follow the product label or a clinician's advice.

### **Acetate**

The salt or ester of acetic acid; acetate is also a two-carbon metabolic substrate that can be converted to acetyl-CoA.

### **Acetylcysteine**

A cysteine derivative used as a mucolytic and as the antidote for acetaminophen poisoning because it replenishes glutathione and helps detoxify its harmful metabolite.

### **ACh (Acetylcholine)**

Acetylcholine, a neurotransmitter released at the neuromuscular junction and in autonomic and central nervous systems; it acts through nicotinic and muscarinic receptors.

### **AChE (Acetylcholinesterase)**

An enzyme that rapidly breaks down acetylcholine into acetate and choline, terminating cholinergic signaling at synapses and neuromuscular junctions.

### **Achillobursitis**

Inflammation of a bursa near the Achilles tendon, causing pain, tenderness, swelling, or friction-related discomfort at the back of the heel.

### **Achoo Syndrome**

The photic sneeze reflex: repeated sneezing triggered by sudden exposure to bright light, especially after entering sunlight from darkness.

### **Acid Indigestion**

Dyspepsia or upper-abdominal discomfort that may include burning, fullness, belching, or nausea; it can accompany reflux, gastritis, ulcer disease, or other conditions.

### **Acidophilus**

*Lactobacillus acidophilus*, a lactic-acid-producing bacterium found in the intestinal and genital microbiota and used in some fermented foods and probiotic products.

### **Acinus, Pulmonary**

The portion of a lung supplied by a terminal bronchiole and containing respiratory bronchioles, alveolar ducts, and alveoli where gas exchange occurs.

### **Acou-**

A medical combining form referring to hearing or sound, as in acoustic nerve, audiology, and acoumeter.

### **Acoustic**

Relating to sound, hearing, or the physical properties and transmission of sound waves.

### **Acquired**

Developed after birth rather than being present at birth or inherited; an acquired condition may result from infection, exposure, injury, aging, or another

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later event.

### **Acquired Immunity**

Immune protection that develops after infection, vaccination, or transfer of antibodies, involving adaptive immune responses directed toward specific antigens.

### **Acrocentric Chromosome**

A chromosome whose centromere lies close to one end, producing a very short p arm and a longer q arm; human acrocentric chromosomes include 13, 14, 15, 21, and 22.

### **Acrodynia**

A painful condition with red, swollen, sweaty hands and feet, classically associated with mercury poisoning and historically called pink disease in children.

### **Acrophobia**

An excessive, persistent fear of heights that causes marked anxiety, avoidance, or impairment beyond the ordinary caution associated with high places.

### **Actinic**

Relating to ultraviolet radiation from sunlight or UV lamps; chronic actinic exposure can cause sunburn, photoaging, and actinic keratoses.

### **Acu-**

A combining form meaning sharp, pointed, or related to acuity; in medical terms it may refer to sharp sensation or vision, as in acuity, acute, or acupuncture, depending on the word formed.

### **Acute Idiopathic Polyneuritis**

Guillain-Barré syndrome, an acute immune-mediated disorder of peripheral nerves that usually causes progressive symmetric weakness and reduced reflexes and may impair breathing.

### **Acute Illness**

A disease or health problem that begins suddenly or over a short period and generally lasts a limited time, although its severity may range from mild to

life-threatening.

### **Acute Mountain Sickness (AMS)**

A high-altitude illness caused by insufficient acclimatization, typically producing headache with nausea, dizziness, fatigue, or sleep disturbance after ascent.

### **Acute Myocardial Infarction**

Sudden death of heart muscle caused by prolonged inadequate coronary blood flow, usually from an acutely obstructed coronary artery; it is a medical emergency.

### **Acute Thrombocytopenic Purpura**

An acute disorder with a markedly reduced platelet count and bleeding or purpura, historically used for immune thrombocytopenic purpura, often following an infection in children.

### **Acyclovir**

An antiviral drug that inhibits herpesvirus DNA polymerase and is used for infections caused by herpes simplex virus and varicella-zoster virus.

### **Ad Lib**

A prescription or clinical instruction meaning as desired or as tolerated, from the Latin *ad libitum*.

### **Ad-**

A medical prefix meaning toward, to, or near, as in adduction (movement toward the midline) and adrenal (near the kidney).

### **ADA Deficiency**

An inherited lack of adenosine deaminase activity that causes toxic purine metabolites to accumulate and can produce severe combined immunodeficiency affecting both T- and B-cell function.

### **Adamantine**

Hard or resembling diamond; in dentistry, adamantine refers to enamel or enamel-like tissue.

### **ADCC (Antibody-Dependent**

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### **Cell-Mediated Cytotox.)**

Antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity, in which immune effector cells such as natural killer cells recognize antibodies attached to a target cell and destroy it.

### **ADD (Attention Deficit Disorder)**

An older term for attention-deficit disorder, now generally classified within attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder, especially presentations dominated by inattention.

### **Addison Anemia**

An older name for pernicious anemia, a vitamin B12-deficiency megaloblastic anemia caused by inadequate intrinsic factor and impaired B12 absorption.

### **Addisonian Anemia**

Another historical term for pernicious anemia, in which autoimmune loss of gastric parietal-cell function or intrinsic factor causes vitamin B12 deficiency.

### **Additive Genetic Effects**

The contributions of individual alleles that combine approximately additively to influence a measurable trait, without requiring interaction between those alleles.

### **Adductor Muscle**

A muscle that moves a body part toward the body's midline or, for a digit, toward the axis of the hand or foot.

### **Aden-**

A combining form meaning gland or glandular tissue, as in adenitis and adenoma.

### **Adeno-**

A combining form referring to a gland or glandular tissue, as in adenovirus, adenoid, and adenocarcinoma.

### **Adenoiditis**

Inflammation or infection of the adenoids, the pha-

ryngeal tonsil behind the nose, which may cause nasal obstruction, mouth breathing, snoring, or ear problems.

### **Adenopathy**

Disease or enlargement of a gland, most often used for lymph-node enlargement or abnormal lymph-node involvement.

### **Adenosine**

A purine nucleoside made of adenine linked to ribose; it participates in cellular energy transfer and signaling and can transiently slow atrioventricular-node conduction when given medically.

### **Adenosine Deaminase (ADA) Deficiency**

An inherited purine-metabolism disorder in which toxic deoxyadenosine metabolites accumulate and damage lymphocytes, commonly causing severe combined immunodeficiency.

### **ADHD (Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder)**

A neurodevelopmental disorder involving persistent inattention and/or hyperactivity-impulsivity that begins in childhood and impairs functioning in more than one setting.

### **ADI**

Acceptable daily intake: the estimated amount of a substance that can be consumed every day over a lifetime without appreciable health risk, based on available evidence and safety factors.

### **Adipose**

Relating to body fat or composed of adipose tissue, which stores energy and also functions as an endocrine and immune-active organ.

### **Adiposity**

The amount or distribution of body fat; excess adiposity is associated with increased risk of metabolic, cardiovascular, and mechanical disease.

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## Adjacent

Next to, close to, or sharing a boundary with another structure, tissue, organ, or lesion.

## Adjuvant

An added treatment or substance that enhances the effect of a primary treatment; in vaccines, an adjuvant strengthens the immune response to an antigen.

## ADLs (Activities Of Daily Living)

Basic self-care activities such as bathing, dressing, toileting, transferring, eating, and maintaining continence; ADL ability is used to assess functional independence.

## Admission

The process of accepting a patient into a hospital or other facility for evaluation, treatment, monitoring, or care.

## Adrenal Failure

Inadequate production of adrenal hormones, especially cortisol and sometimes aldosterone; severe acute deficiency can cause adrenal crisis with hypotension and shock.

## Adrenaline

Epinephrine, a hormone and neurotransmitter released during stress that increases heart rate and contractility, constricts some blood vessels, and relaxes bronchial muscle.

## ADU

Accessory dwelling unit, a secondary independent residential unit located on the same property as a primary home.

## Adult Primary Liver Cancer

Cancer that begins in the liver of an adult, most commonly hepatocellular carcinoma or intrahepatic cholangiocarcinoma, rather than cancer that has spread to the liver from another organ.

## Advance Directives

Written instructions about a person's future medical-care preferences and/or designation of a health-care proxy if the person later cannot make or communicate decisions.

## Adventitious

Abnormal, unexpected, or arising from an unusual location or process; adventitious lung sounds include crackles, wheezes, and other added breath sounds.

## Adverse Effect

An unintended and harmful or bothersome effect of a medicine or other treatment given at normal doses or for an intended purpose.

## Aer-, Aero-

A combining form meaning air or gas, as in aerobic, aerosol, and aerophagia.

## Aerophobia

An excessive fear of flying or air travel that causes significant anxiety, avoidance, or impairment.

## Aerotitis

Ear pain or middle-ear injury caused by failure to equalize pressure during rapid changes in altitude, such as during aircraft ascent or descent.

## Aesculapius

The Roman name for Asclepius, the Greek god of healing; the name is associated with medicine and the rod-and-serpent medical symbol.

## Aetiology

The cause or causes of a disease, injury, symptom, or other medical condition; also spelled etiology.

## Affect

The observable expression of a person's emotional state, including facial expression, voice, posture, and emotional responsiveness.

## Afferent

Carrying signals toward a central organ or structure;

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afferent nerves transmit sensory information from the body toward the brain and spinal cord.

### **Affinity**

The strength of attraction or binding between two molecules, such as an antibody and antigen, receptor and ligand, or enzyme and substrate.

### **AFIP**

The Armed Forces Institute of Pathology, a former United States institution known for consultation, education, and research in diagnostic pathology.

### **AFO (Ankle-Foot Orthosis)**

A brace that supports the ankle and foot, helps control alignment and motion, and may improve walking in people with weakness, spasticity, instability, or foot drop.

### **Afterbirth**

The placenta and fetal membranes expelled from the uterus after delivery of the baby.

### **Age By Decade**

Classification of a person's age into ten-year groups, such as the twenties, thirties, or seventies, for demographic description or analysis.

### **Agent, Tocolytic**

A medicine that reduces uterine contractions, used selectively to delay preterm birth long enough for corticosteroids, transfer, or other preparations to take effect.

### **Aggressive**

Characterized by forceful or hostile behavior, or by rapid growth and invasive or destructive clinical behavior, depending on context.

### **Agita**

An informal term for heartburn, indigestion, or an uneasy feeling of stomach discomfort; its meaning can vary by region and context.

### **Ague**

A fever, often associated with malaria, marked by recurrent episodes of chills, fever, and sweating; the term can also mean a fit of shivering.

### **Agyrophobia**

An excessive, persistent fear of crossing streets, highways, or other thoroughfares, causing anxiety or avoidance despite limited objective danger.

### **AHD**

An abbreviation that may mean alveolar hydatid disease, American Hospital Directory, or atherosclerotic heart disease; the clinical context determines the meaning.

### **AID (Artificial Insemination By Donor)**

Intrauterine insemination using sperm from a donor other than the intended mother's partner to attempt fertilization and pregnancy.

### **AIH (Artificial Insemination By Husband)**

Intrauterine insemination using sperm from the woman's male partner; it is also called homologous insemination.

### **Air Bag**

An inflatable vehicle safety device that rapidly deploys during a collision to reduce impact with the steering wheel, dashboard, or window; it supplements seat belts.

### **Air-Conditioner Lung**

Hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhaled mold, fungus, or other contaminants from air-conditioning or humidifying systems.

### **AK**

Actinic keratosis, a rough, scaly precancerous skin lesion caused by chronic ultraviolet exposure.

### **AKA (Above The Knee Amputation)**

Amputation of the lower limb through the thigh above the knee joint, usually performed for severe

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vascular disease, infection, trauma, or cancer.

### **Akinetic**

Characterized by little or no voluntary movement; akinesia may result from neurologic disease, medication effects, or severe motor impairment.

### **ALA**

An abbreviation for alpha-linolenic acid, an essential omega-3 fatty acid, or aminolevulinic acid, a heme-pathway compound used topically in some photodynamic treatments; context determines the meaning.

### **Alb-**

A prefix derived from the Latin *albus*, meaning white, as in albino and albinism.

### **Albinism, Oculocutaneous**

An inherited disorder of melanin production affecting the skin, hair, and eyes, often causing light sensitivity, nystagmus, reduced visual acuity, and increased sun sensitivity.

### **Albino**

A person or animal with albinism; person-first language such as “person with albinism” is generally preferred.

### **Albumen**

The white of an egg, composed largely of water and proteins; it is distinct from albumin, the major protein in blood plasma.

### **Alembic**

A distillation apparatus historically used in chemistry and laboratory work to separate or purify substances by differences in volatility.

### **Algia**

A word ending meaning pain, as in neuralgia, myalgia, and arthralgia.

### **Alimentary**

Relating to food, nourishment, or the organs and

processes of digestion.

### **Alkaloid**

A naturally occurring nitrogen-containing organic compound, often produced by plants, with potentially potent physiologic or pharmacologic effects.

### **Allelic**

Relating to an allele, one of two or more alternative forms of a gene at a particular genomic location.

### **Allergic Contact Dermatitis**

A delayed, T-cell-mediated skin reaction after contact with a substance to which the person has become sensitized, causing itching, redness, swelling, and sometimes blisters or scaling.

### **Allogeneic**

Derived from a genetically different individual of the same species, as in an allogeneic blood, tissue, stem-cell, or organ transplant.

### **Allopathic Medicine**

A historical term commonly used for conventional, evidence-based medical practice; it is not a precise scientific classification and may be used differently by different groups.

### **Allopathy**

A historical label for conventional medical treatment, often contrasted with homeopathy; modern clinical practice is more accurately described by its specific methods and evidence.

### **Alongshan Virus (ALSV)**

A tick-associated segmented RNA virus reported to cause a febrile illness, often with headache, fatigue, nausea, or neurologic symptoms; its epidemiology and clinical significance remain under study.

### **Alprazolam**

A short- to intermediate-acting benzodiazepine used mainly for anxiety and panic disorder; it can cause sedation, dependence, withdrawal, and dangerous respiratory depression with opioids or other depres-



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sants.

### **ALT (Alanine Aminotransferase)**

An enzyme concentrated in liver cells; an increased blood ALT level may indicate hepatocellular injury but must be interpreted with other tests and clinical findings.

### **Alternative Medicine**

A nonconventional health practice used instead of standard medical treatment; evidence, safety, and interactions vary widely, and replacing effective care can be harmful.

### **Altitude Sickness**

Illness caused by rapid ascent to high altitude without adequate acclimatization, ranging from acute mountain sickness to life-threatening pulmonary or cerebral edema.

### **Alveolar**

Relating to an alveolus, especially one of the tiny air sacs in the lungs where oxygen and carbon dioxide are exchanged.

### **Alveolar Hydatid Disease**

A serious parasitic infection caused by the larval stage of *Echinococcus multilocularis*, usually producing an infiltrative, tumor-like lesion in the liver that can spread to other organs.

### **Alveolitis**

Inflammation of the pulmonary alveoli, usually causing cough and breathlessness, or inflammation of a tooth socket after extraction, called alveolar osteitis or dry socket; the organ involved distinguishes the two meanings.

### **Amastia**

Congenital absence of one or both breasts, sometimes accompanied by absence of the nipple or pectoral muscles and other developmental anomalies.

### **Amathophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of dust that causes

significant anxiety, avoidance, or impairment.

### **Ambidextrous**

Able to use the right and left hands with approximately equal skill or preference.

### **Ambient**

Surrounding or present in the immediate environment, as in ambient temperature, light, noise, or air.

### **AMC (Arthrogryposis Multiplex Congenita)**

A group of congenital conditions characterized by multiple joint contractures present at birth, often with muscle weakness or abnormal development of nerves, muscles, or connective tissue.

### **Amelioration**

Improvement or reduction in the severity of a symptom, disease, impairment, or other adverse condition.

### **American Academy Of Pediatrics**

A professional organization of pediatricians that promotes the health and well-being of infants, children, adolescents, and young adults through clinical guidance, education, advocacy, and research.

### **American Dental Association (ADA)**

A professional organization representing dentistry and supporting oral-health education, standards, advocacy, and practice resources in the United States.

### **AMI**

Acute myocardial infarction, the sudden death of heart muscle caused by prolonged inadequate coronary blood flow.

### **Amino Acid Symbols**

Standard one-letter and three-letter abbreviations used to identify the 20 common protein-building amino acids in biochemical and genetic notation.

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### **Aminotransferase**

An enzyme that transfers an amino group between an amino acid and an alpha-keto acid; clinically measured examples include ALT and AST.

### **Amitriptyline**

A tricyclic antidepressant that affects serotonin and norepinephrine signaling and is also used for selected chronic pain, migraine-prevention, and sleep-related indications.

### **AML**

Acute myeloid leukemia, an aggressive cancer of immature myeloid blood-cell precursors that crowds the bone marrow and impairs normal blood-cell production.

### **Amok**

A historical culture-related term for a sudden episode of uncontrolled, often violent behavior followed by exhaustion or amnesia; modern assessment considers psychiatric, neurologic, substance-related, and cultural factors.

### **Amphetamine**

A central nervous system stimulant that increases catecholamine signaling and is used in selected attention-deficit/hyperactivity and sleep disorders; misuse can cause dependence and cardiovascular or psychiatric harm.

### **Ampulla**

A widened portion of a tubular structure, such as the ampulla of the bile and pancreatic ducts or the ampulla of a fallopian tube.

### **Amusia**

An acquired or developmental inability to perceive, recognize, produce, or understand music despite otherwise adequate hearing and language ability.

### **Amygdaloid Nucleus**

A group of nuclei in the medial temporal lobe involved in processing emotional significance, fear responses, learning, memory, and autonomic re-

sponses.

### **Amyl-**

A combining form referring to starch or a starch-like substance, as in amylase and amyloid.

### **Amylo-**

A combining form referring to starch-like material or amyloid protein deposits.

### **An-**

A prefix meaning without, lacking, or not, as in anoxia, anesthesia, and anencephaly.

### **ANA**

Antinuclear antibody, an autoantibody directed against components of cell nuclei; ANA testing can support evaluation of autoimmune disease but is not diagnostic by itself.

### **Anaesthesia**

Reversible loss of sensation, with or without loss of consciousness, produced by medicines or other techniques; also spelled anesthesia.

### **Anal Papilla**

A small normal projection of mucosa at the anal canal's dentate line, where columnar and squamous epithelium meet.

### **Anal Papillae**

Multiple small mucosal projections at the dentate line of the anal canal; they are usually normal but may become enlarged or symptomatic.

### **Analog**

A structure, substance, or process that resembles another and performs a similar function but is not necessarily chemically or structurally identical.

### **Analogous**

Similar in function or purpose to another structure or process, despite having a different origin or structure.

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## **Analysis**

Systematic examination or interpretation of a specimen, measurement, dataset, symptom pattern, or clinical problem.

## **Anaphia**

Loss or absence of the sense of touch or tactile sensation.

## **Anaphylactoid Purpura**

An older term for IgA vasculitis, an immune-mediated small-vessel vasculitis causing palpable purpura, often with joint, abdominal, or kidney involvement.

## **Anaptic**

Lacking a normal sense of touch or tactile sensation; the term is rarely used in modern clinical writing.

## **Anastrozole**

An aromatase inhibitor that lowers estrogen production and is used mainly in hormone-receptor-positive breast cancer, particularly after menopause.

## **Anatomic Orientation Terms**

Standard words used to describe the position and relationships of body structures, including superior, inferior, anterior, posterior, medial, lateral, proximal, distal, superficial, and deep.

## **Anatomy, Gross**

The study of body structures visible without a microscope, including organs, regions, bones, muscles, vessels, and their relationships.

## **ANC**

Absolute neutrophil count, the number of circulating neutrophils in a blood sample; a low ANC indicates increased risk of bacterial and fungal infection.

## **Androgenic**

Relating to androgens or producing masculine sexual development and other androgen-mediated effects.

## **Android Pelvis**

A relatively heart-shaped or funnel-shaped pelvic configuration with a narrower midpelvis, which may increase the risk of obstructed labor compared with a gynecoid pelvis.

## **Anemic**

Having anemia, meaning reduced red-cell mass or hemoglobin and therefore reduced blood oxygen-carrying capacity.

## **Anger**

An emotional response involving displeasure or perceived threat, ranging from mild irritation to intense hostility; persistent or harmful anger may require clinical assessment.

## **Angiogram**

An image of blood vessels, usually obtained after contrast material is injected, used to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, malformation, or bleeding.

## **Angioneurotic Edema, Hereditary**

Hereditary angioedema, an inherited bradykinin-mediated disorder causing recurrent swelling of the skin, gastrointestinal tract, or airway, usually without hives.

## **Angiopathy**

Disease or abnormality of blood vessels, including changes caused by diabetes, inflammation, atherosclerosis, trauma, or inherited disorders.

## **Angiotensin**

A family of peptides in the renin–angiotensin system that regulate blood pressure and fluid balance, with angiotensin II causing vasoconstriction and stimulating aldosterone release.

## **Angiotensin Converting Enzyme**

An enzyme that converts angiotensin I to vasoconstricting angiotensin II and also breaks down bradykinin; it is inhibited by ACE-inhibitor medicines.

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### **Angiotensin Receptor Blocker**

A medicine that blocks angiotensin II at the AT1 receptor, reducing vasoconstriction and aldosterone effects; it is used for hypertension, heart failure, and selected kidney disease.

### **Angle-Closure Glaucoma**

Glaucoma caused by narrowing or closure of the drainage angle, which can abruptly raise eye pressure and threaten vision; acute attacks require emergency treatment.

### **Anion**

Anion is an ion with a net negative electrical charge, such as chloride, bicarbonate, or phosphate in body fluids.

### **Aniso-**

A combining form meaning unequal or unequal in size, number, or degree.

### **Anisometropia**

A difference in the refractive power of the two eyes, which can cause unequal image focus, blurred vision, or amblyopia.

### **Ankle Bone**

A bone forming the ankle joint, especially the talus or the distal tibia and fibula that form the ankle mortise.

### **Ankylose**

To become stiff or immobile at a joint, sometimes because the joint surfaces become fused.

### **Ankylosing**

Causing or involving progressive stiffness and fixation of a joint, often through fibrous or bony fusion.

### **Annulus**

A ring-shaped structure or band; examples include the annulus fibrosus around an intervertebral disk and the fibrous rings around heart valves.

### **Anogenital Tract**

The connected anatomic region comprising the anus, perianal tissues, genital structures, and related mucosal surfaces.

### **Anomaly**

A deviation from the usual structure, development, function, or measurement of the body; it may be harmless or clinically significant.

### **Anorgasm**

Inability to achieve orgasm despite adequate sexual stimulation; possible contributors include medications, hormonal or neurologic disorders, psychological factors, and relationship difficulties.

### **Antagonist**

A substance, drug, muscle, or other factor that opposes or blocks the action of another; a receptor antagonist binds without activating the receptor.

### **Antegrade**

Moving or occurring in the normal forward direction of flow or conduction, such as blood flow away from the heart or electrical conduction through the usual pathway.

### **Anterior Cruciate Ligament**

A strong ligament inside the knee that runs from the femur to the tibia and limits forward movement and rotation of the tibia.

### **Antero-**

A combining form meaning anterior or toward the front.

### **Anterolisthesis**

Forward displacement of one vertebral body relative to the vertebra below it, usually in the spine.

### **Anteroposterior**

Directed from front to back; an anteroposterior radiographic view passes through the body from the anterior surface toward the posterior surface.

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### **Anteroposterior (AP)**

Directed from the front of the body toward the back; an AP radiograph is made with the X-ray beam entering anteriorly and exiting posteriorly.

### **Anti-**

A prefix meaning against, opposed to, or preventing a specified process or condition.

### **Anti-Infective**

A medicine or other agent used to prevent or treat infection caused by microorganisms, including bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites.

### **Antibacterial**

Destroying bacteria or inhibiting their growth; the term may describe a drug, disinfectant, surface treatment, or immune defense.

### **Anticholinergic**

Blocking the effects of acetylcholine, commonly at muscarinic receptors; these drugs can reduce secretions and smooth-muscle activity but may cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, or confusion.

### **Anticoagulant Agent**

A drug that reduces blood clot formation by interfering with the coagulation cascade; examples include heparin, warfarin, and direct oral anticoagulants.

### **Antidepressants**

Medicines used mainly to treat depressive disorders; different classes alter serotonin, norepinephrine, dopamine, or other signaling and may also treat anxiety, pain, or related conditions.

### **Antidiabetic Agent**

A medicine that lowers blood glucose or improves glucose regulation in diabetes, such as insulin, metformin, sulfonylureas, or GLP-1 receptor agonists.

### **Antidiuretic Hormone (ADH)**

Vasopressin, a hormone released from the posterior pituitary that increases water reabsorption in the

kidney and, at higher concentrations, constricts blood vessels.

### **Antiestrogen**

A drug that blocks estrogen effects or reduces estrogen production; it may be used in hormone-sensitive breast cancer or to alter reproductive hormone signaling.

### **Antifungal Agent**

A drug or chemical that kills fungi or inhibits their growth, used to treat fungal infections of the skin, mucosa, or internal organs.

### **Antifungal Medication**

A medicine used to treat fungal infection; the choice and route depend on the organism and site, and examples include azoles, terbinafine, polyenes, and echinocandins.

### **Antihistamines**

Medicines that block histamine receptors; H1 antihistamines relieve allergy symptoms and some cause sedation, while H2 antihistamines reduce gastric acid secretion.

### **Antimalarial**

A drug used to prevent or treat malaria caused by Plasmodium parasites; selection depends on species, disease severity, resistance, and geographic exposure.

### **Antimetabolite**

A compound resembling a substance needed for metabolism or DNA synthesis that disrupts cellular processes; many antimetabolites are used as anticancer or immunosuppressive drugs.

### **Antimicrobial Agent**

A substance that kills microorganisms or inhibits their growth, including antibacterial, antiviral, antifungal, and antiparasitic agents.

### **Antimicrobial Drug**

A medicine used to treat infection by bacteria,

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viruses, fungi, or parasites; the drug is selected according to the organism, infection site, and patient factors.

### **Antimony**

A metallic chemical element whose compounds can be toxic; selected antimony compounds, such as the pentavalent agents, have been used to treat leishmaniasis.

### **Antiprotozoal**

Destroying protozoa or inhibiting their growth; antiprotozoal medicines treat infections such as malaria, giardiasis, or amoebiasis.

### **Antiprotozoal Drug**

A medicine used to prevent or treat disease caused by protozoa, including drugs directed against malaria, intestinal protozoa, or tissue parasites.

### **Antiretroviral**

Active against retroviruses; antiretroviral medicines inhibit different stages of HIV replication and are generally used in combination therapy.

### **Antithyroid Drug**

A medicine that reduces thyroid hormone production or release, used to treat hyperthyroidism; examples include methimazole, propylthiouracil, and radioactive iodine.

### **Antrum**

A cavity or chamber in an organ, especially the lower part of the stomach near the pylorus or the air-filled maxillary sinus.

### **AOA**

An abbreviation commonly used for the American Optometric Association; in other clinical contexts it may have a different expansion.

### **Aortal**

Relating to the aorta, the large artery that carries blood from the left ventricle to the systemic circulation.

### **Aortic**

Relating to the aorta, the main artery carrying blood from the heart to the body.

### **AP**

An abbreviation commonly meaning anteroposterior, or directed from front to back; in some contexts it may have another medical expansion.

### **AP, X-Ray**

An anteroposterior radiographic projection in which the X-ray beam travels from the front of the body toward the back.

### **APA**

An abbreviation for American Psychiatric Association, American Psychological Association, or American Podiatry Association; it can also mean antiphospholipid antibody or alkaline phosphatase activity.

### **APC**

An abbreviation that may refer to an antigen-presenting cell, an argon plasma coagulation procedure, or another context-specific medical term.

### **APC (Immunology)**

Antigen-presenting cell, an immune cell that processes antigens and displays peptide fragments on major histocompatibility complex molecules to activate T cells.

### **APC (Medication)**

A combination of aspirin, phenacetin, and caffeine; phenacetin-containing APC products were associated with kidney injury and are no longer widely used.

### **APECED (Autoimmune Polyendocrinopathy)**

An inherited autoimmune syndrome, also called autoimmune polyendocrine syndrome type 1, characterized by chronic mucocutaneous candidiasis, hypoparathyroidism, adrenal insufficiency, and other autoimmune disorders.



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## **Apex**

The tip or pointed end of a structure; examples include the apex of the heart, formed mainly by the left ventricle, and the upper tip of a lung.

## **Aphasia**

Loss or impairment of the ability to speak, often used as an older or less precise term related to aphasia.

## **Apical**

Relating to or located at the apex, or tip, of a structure such as the lung, heart, or tooth.

## **APLS (Antiphospholipid Antibody Syndrome)**

An autoimmune disorder in which antiphospholipid antibodies are associated with abnormal blood clotting, recurrent pregnancy loss, thrombocytopenia, and sometimes migraine or heart-valve abnormalities.

## **Apneic**

Relating to or characterized by apnea, meaning a temporary cessation of breathing.

## **Apophenia**

The perception of meaningful patterns or connections in unrelated or random events; marked apophenia may occur in some psychiatric or neurologic conditions.

## **Appendiceal**

Relating to the vermiform appendix, a narrow pouch projecting from the beginning of the large intestine.

## **Appendiceal Cancer**

A malignant tumor arising in the appendix; types include neuroendocrine tumors and epithelial neoplasms, which can rupture or spread mucus-producing tumor cells within the abdomen.

## **Appendiceal Rupture**

Tearing or perforation of an inflamed appendix, allowing intestinal contents to enter the abdomen and

potentially causing peritonitis or an abscess.

## **Apposition**

Placement of two structures next to or against each other; in wound care, good apposition means that tissue edges are accurately aligned.

## **APS (Autoimmune Polyglandular Syndrome)**

A group of disorders in which autoimmune disease affects multiple endocrine glands; manifestations vary by type and may include adrenal insufficiency, hypoparathyroidism, and thyroid disease.

## **Aquaporin**

A membrane water-channel protein that permits rapid movement of water across cells; aquaporin-2 in kidney collecting ducts is regulated by vasopressin.

## **ARD**

An abbreviation that may mean acute respiratory disease or acute respiratory distress; the precise expansion depends on the clinical context.

## **Arm**

The upper limb between the shoulder and elbow; in everyday use, the term may also include the entire upper extremity.

## **Aromatase**

An enzyme that converts androgens into estrogens in tissues such as the ovaries, adipose tissue, and breast; it is inhibited by drugs such as anastrozole.

## **Aromatherapy**

Use of essential oils or other plant-derived scents, usually by inhalation or topical application, for perceived relaxation or symptom relief; evidence and safety vary by oil and use.

## **Arrector Pili**

A small involuntary smooth muscle attached to a hair follicle that contracts to raise the hair and produce gooseflesh.

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## **Arsenic**

A naturally occurring metalloid that is toxic in many forms; exposure can cause gastrointestinal, neurologic, cardiovascular, and skin effects, while arsenic trioxide has specific therapeutic uses.

## **ART (Antiretroviral Therapy)**

Combination treatment with antiretroviral medicines that suppress HIV replication, preserve immune function, and reduce the risk of HIV transmission and disease progression.

## **Artemisinin**

A plant-derived antimalarial compound from *Artemisia annua*; artemisinin derivatives are used in combination regimens, especially for falciparum malaria.

## **Arteria Femoralis**

The femoral artery, the major artery of the thigh and continuation of the external iliac artery below the inguinal ligament.

## **Arterial Blood Gas (ABG)**

A test of arterial blood that measures pH, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and usually bicarbonate or related values to assess oxygenation, ventilation, and acid-base balance.

## **Arterial Tension**

The pressure or partial pressure measured in arterial blood; depending on context, it may refer to blood pressure or to the tension of an arterial gas such as oxygen or carbon dioxide.

## **Arteriosclerotic Retinopathy**

Retinal vascular changes associated with thickening or hardening of small arteries, often occurring with chronic hypertension or atherosclerotic disease.

## **Arteriovenous Malformation (AVM)**

An abnormal tangle of arteries and veins connected without the normal capillary bed; an AVM can bleed, cause seizures or neurologic symptoms, or produce high-flow complications.

## **Arthro-**

A combining form meaning joint.

## **Arthrogram**

An image of a joint obtained after contrast material is introduced into or around the joint, used to evaluate structures such as cartilage, ligaments, or the joint capsule.

## **Arthrosis**

Degenerative disease of a joint, characterized by progressive cartilage loss and changes in the underlying bone; osteoarthritis is the most common example.

## **Articulation**

A joint or connection between bones; the term also refers to the production and clarity of speech sounds by the vocal organs.

## **Artificial Abortion**

An induced termination of pregnancy using medication, a procedure, or both, rather than a spontaneous miscarriage.

## **Artificial Insemination By Husband (AIH)**

Placement of sperm from a woman's husband or male partner into her reproductive tract to achieve pregnancy, usually by intrauterine insemination.

## **ASA (Drug Caution Code)**

A medication caution code indicating that a product contains acetylsalicylic acid, or aspirin.

## **Ascorbic Acid**

Vitamin C, a water-soluble vitamin needed for collagen formation, wound healing, antioxidant activity, and normal immune and connective-tissue function.

## **Ascus**

An abbreviation for atypical squamous cells of undetermined significance, a Pap-test finding in which cervical squamous cells are abnormal but not clearly precancerous.

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### **Aseptic**

Free from disease-causing microorganisms, or performed using methods intended to prevent microbial contamination; it does not necessarily mean sterile.

### **ASL**

American Sign Language, a visual language used by many Deaf and hard-of-hearing people.

### **ASOT**

Antistreptolysin O titer, a blood test measuring antibodies to streptolysin O produced by group A *Streptococcus*.

### **Asp**

The standard amino-acid abbreviation for aspartic acid, an acidic amino acid incorporated into proteins and involved in cellular metabolism.

### **Aspartame**

A low-calorie artificial sweetener made from two amino-acid components; people with phenylketonuria must avoid it because it provides phenylalanine.

### **Aspartate Aminotransferase (AST)**

An enzyme found mainly in the liver, heart, and skeletal muscle; increased blood AST can indicate injury to these tissues, especially liver injury.

### **Aspirate**

To withdraw fluid, cells, or tissue with suction, usually through a needle; to aspirate can also mean to inhale material into the airway.

### **Aspirin**

Acetylsalicylic acid, a salicylate that relieves pain and fever, reduces inflammation, and irreversibly inhibits platelet aggregation; it can cause gastrointestinal bleeding and is generally avoided in children with viral illness.

### **Association**

A relationship or co-occurrence between two variables, findings, or conditions; association alone does

not prove that one causes the other.

### **Asthenic**

Characterized by reduced strength or a slender, lightly built body habitus; in clinical descriptions it may refer to physical weakness or, less precisely, an asthenic constitution and should be distinguished from asthenia as a symptom.

### **Athelia**

Congenital or acquired absence of one or both nipples.

### **Atherosclerotic**

Relating to atherosclerosis, the buildup of lipid-rich plaque and fibrous tissue in arterial walls that can narrow arteries or promote thrombosis.

### **Atlas And Axis Joint**

The atlantoaxial joint between the first cervical vertebra, the atlas, and the second, the axis; it permits much of the head's rotation.

### **ATM**

An abbreviation that may mean the temporomandibular joint or ataxia-telangiectasia mutated, a protein kinase involved in DNA-damage repair; context determines the meaning.

### **Atom**

The smallest unit of an element that retains that element's chemical properties, consisting of a nucleus surrounded by electrons.

### **Atonic**

Lacking normal muscle tone or contractile strength; an atonic bladder, for example, does not contract effectively to empty urine.

### **Atopic**

Relating to an inherited or acquired tendency to develop allergic reactions such as eczema, allergic rhinitis, or asthma.

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## **ATP**

Adenosine triphosphate, the principal energy-transfer molecule in cells; hydrolysis of its phosphate bonds powers many cellular processes.

## **Atresia**

Congenital absence, closure, or severe narrowing of a normal body opening or passage, such as the intestinal, biliary, or pulmonary outflow tract.

## **Atria**

The two upper chambers of the heart, which receive blood from the systemic and pulmonary veins and pass it to the ventricles.

## **Atrial**

Relating to an atrium, especially one of the two upper chambers of the heart.

## **Atrial Fib**

Atrial fibrillation, an irregular and often rapid atrial rhythm that can reduce coordinated heart contraction and increase the risk of blood clots and stroke.

## **Atrial Septum**

The wall separating the right and left atria; an atrial septal defect is an abnormal opening in this wall.

## **Atrioventricular (AV)**

Relating to an atrium and ventricle, especially the atrioventricular valves or the conduction system connecting the atria and ventricles.

## **Atropine**

An anticholinergic drug that blocks muscarinic acetylcholine receptors; it can increase heart rate, reduce secretions, dilate the pupils, and treat selected poisonings or bradycardia.

## **Attention**

The ability to select, focus on, and sustain mental processing of relevant information while limiting distraction.

## **Attention Deficit Disorder (ADD)**

An older term for a condition now generally included under attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder, especially a presentation dominated by persistent inattention that interferes with daily functioning.

## **Attenuated**

Weakened or reduced in force, severity, concentration, or biological activity; an attenuated vaccine contains a weakened form of a microorganism.

## **Atypical**

Not typical of the usual appearance, behavior, structure, or course of a condition; atypical does not by itself indicate whether a finding is benign or malignant.

## **Atypical Measles Syndrome (AMS)**

A rare severe illness formerly reported after exposure to measles virus in people who had received an inactivated measles vaccine; it can cause unusual rash, high fever, and pneumonia.

## **Auditory Acuity**

The sensitivity or sharpness of hearing, commonly assessed by determining the softest sounds a person can detect at different frequencies.

## **Auditory Perception**

The brain's process of detecting, recognizing, and interpreting sounds received through the auditory system.

## **Autistic Savant**

A person with autism who has an unusually advanced, specific ability—such as in music, art, calculation, or memory—relative to overall functioning.

## **Autoimmune**

Relating to an immune response directed against the body's own cells, tissues, or molecules.

## **Autoimmunity**

An immune response against self-antigens; it can be harmless or can cause autoimmune disease when it

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damages tissues or disrupts their function.

### **Autologous**

Derived from or involving the same individual who will receive it, such as an autologous blood transfusion or stem-cell transplant.

### **Autolysis**

Self-digestion of cells or tissues by their own enzymes, commonly occurring after cell death and contributing to decomposition.

### **Automated External Defibrillator**

A portable device that analyzes heart rhythm and delivers an electrical shock when it detects a shockable cardiac arrest rhythm such as ventricular fibrillation.

### **Autonomy, Patient**

A patient's right and capacity to make informed, voluntary decisions about medical care, including accepting or refusing treatment.

### **Autophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of being alone; it may occur as a specific phobia or alongside other anxiety conditions.

### **AV (Atrioventricular)**

An abbreviation for atrioventricular, relating to an atrium and ventricle or to the conduction pathway between them.

### **Avuncular**

Relating to an uncle or resembling the kindly, familiar manner traditionally associated with an uncle.

### **Axial Tomography, Computerized**

Computed tomography, or CT, an imaging method that uses X-rays and computer processing to create cross-sectional images of the body.

### **Ayurveda**

A traditional system of medicine from India that emphasizes balance among bodily principles and uses

individualized diet, lifestyle practices, and herbal or other treatments.

### **Arteries**

Blood vessels that carry blood away from the heart. Most arteries carry oxygenated blood, except the pulmonary and umbilical arteries; their walls contain elastic tissue and smooth muscle to withstand and regulate pressure.

#### **Synonyms:**

arterial vessels

### **ABO Blood Types**

The major blood-group system based on the presence or absence of A and B antigens on red blood cells and corresponding antibodies in plasma.

### **Atopic Dermatitis (Eczema)**

A chronic inflammatory skin condition causing itchy, dry, irritated, or rash-covered skin, often associated with an atopic tendency.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dermatitis, Atopic

### **Actinic Keratosis (Solar Keratosis)**

A rough, scaly precancerous skin lesion caused by long-term ultraviolet exposure and capable of progressing to squamous cell carcinoma.

#### **Synonyms:**

Solar Keratosis

### **Adolescent Obesity**

Obesity during adolescence, assessed using age- and sex-specific growth charts rather than adult BMI thresholds alone. It may affect metabolic, cardiovascular, orthopedic, and psychological health.

### **A & E Medicine**

Accident and emergency medicine provides rapid assessment, stabilization, diagnosis, and initial treatment for acute illness, injury, and other urgent conditions.

### **Abdomen, Diseases Of**

Diseases of the abdomen affect abdominal organs,

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blood vessels, lining, or abdominal wall and may cause pain, vomiting, altered bowel function, bleeding, or distention.

### **Abduct**

To abduct a limb or body part is to move it away from the body's midline; the opposite movement is adduction.

### **ABO Blood Groups**

The ABO blood-group system classifies red cells by A and B antigens and plasma antibodies; compatibility is essential for safe transfusion and transplantation.

### **ABO System**

The major red-cell blood-group system based on whether A and/or B antigens are present on the red-cell surface and the corresponding antibodies are present in plasma. The four principal phenotypes are A, B, AB, and O; correct ABO matching is critical for safe transfusion.

### **Abreaction**

Abreaction is the expression and re-experiencing of intense emotion linked to a distressing memory; it is a historical psychological term and is not itself a diagnosis.

### **Abruptio Placenta**

Abruptio placenta, more commonly called placental abruption, is premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall before delivery, which can cause maternal bleeding and fetal compromise.

### **Abstract**

In medical literature, an abstract is a brief summary of a study or report describing its purpose, methods, main results, and conclusions.

### **Acarus**

Acarus is a mite genus; mites and related arthropods can cause skin infestation, allergy, or occupational exposure depending on the species.

### **Accident And Emergency Medicine**

Accident and emergency medicine is the specialty concerned with immediate evaluation and treatment of acute illness, injury, poisoning, and life-threatening emergencies.

### **Accouchement**

Accouchement is the process of childbirth, including labor, delivery of the infant, and expulsion of the placenta.

### **Accretion**

Accretion is gradual accumulation or growth of material; in medicine it may describe deposits such as dental calculus or mineral buildup around a lesion or device.

### **Acebutolol**

Acebutolol is a beta-adrenergic blocker with intrinsic sympathomimetic activity used in some settings for hypertension and cardiac rhythm disorders; it can slow heart rate and conduction.

### **Acetazolamide**

Acetazolamide inhibits carbonic anhydrase and promotes bicarbonate loss in urine; it is used for glaucoma, altitude illness, selected edema, and some acid-base or neurologic disorders.

### **Acetylsalicyclic Acid**

Acetylsalicyclic acid is the commonly misspelled name for acetylsalicylic acid, or aspirin, a salicylate that reduces pain, fever, and inflammation and inhibits platelet aggregation.

### **Achalasia Of The Cardia**

Achalasia of the cardia is failure of the lower esophageal sphincter to relax with loss of esophageal peristalsis, causing progressive swallowing difficulty, regurgitation, and food retention.

### **Achromia**

Achromia is loss or marked reduction of pigment in skin, hair, eye, or another tissue; causes include genetic disorders, autoimmune depigmentation, injury,



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and chemical exposure.

### **Aciclovir**

Aciclovir, also called acyclovir, is an antiviral drug that inhibits herpesvirus DNA polymerase and is used for infections such as herpes simplex and varicella-zoster.

### **Aciduria**

Aciduria means an abnormally acidic urine or the presence of excess organic acids in urine; it may reflect diet, dehydration, medication, or an inherited metabolic disorder.

### **Acinus**

An acinus is a small functional secretory unit of a gland, such as a pancreatic or salivary acinus, whose cells release their product into a duct.

### **Acne Rosacea**

Acne rosacea is a chronic inflammatory facial skin disorder causing flushing, persistent redness, visible vessels, papules, pustules, or eye symptoms; it is distinct from acne vulgaris.

### **Acro-**

Acro- is a medical word element meaning extremity, tip, or highest part, as in acromegaly and acrocyanosis.

### **Acroparaesthesia**

Acroparaesthesia is tingling, pins-and-needles, burning, or altered sensation in the hands or feet, commonly related to nerve compression, neuropathy, vascular disease, or metabolic causes.

### **ACTH (Adrenocorticotrophic Hormone)**

ACTH is a pituitary hormone that stimulates the adrenal cortex to produce cortisol and some adrenal androgens; testing helps evaluate pituitary and adrenal disorders.

### **Actinomycin D**

Actinomycin D, or dactinomycin, is an antineoplastic antibiotic that blocks DNA-dependent RNA syn-

thesis and is used for selected cancers; myelosuppression and tissue injury are important risks.

### **Acute Life-Threatening Event (ALTE)**

ALTE is an older term for an unexpected infant event involving altered breathing, color, tone, or responsiveness; current practice generally uses the more specific term brief resolved unexplained event (BRUE).

### **Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome (ARDS)**

ARDS is acute inflammatory lung injury causing severe hypoxemia and diffuse pulmonary opacities that are not fully explained by heart failure or fluid overload.

### **Adactyly**

Adactyly is congenital absence of one or more fingers or toes, ranging from loss of a digit to more extensive limb malformation.

### **Adaptation**

Adaptation is the adjustment of a cell, organism, or person to a changing internal or external condition; in medicine it may involve physiologic compensation, behavior, or rehabilitation.

### **Adduct**

To adduct a limb or body part is to move it toward the body's midline; the opposite movement is abduction.

### **Adenolipoma**

An adenolipoma is a usually benign tumor containing both glandular tissue and mature fatty tissue.

### **Adenomatosis**

Adenomatosis is the presence of multiple adenomas or diffuse adenomatous overgrowth in an organ or tissue; its implications depend on the site and underlying syndrome.

### **Adenosine Triphosphate (ATP)**

ATP is the cell's principal immediately usable en-

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ergy carrier; hydrolysis of its high-energy phosphate bonds powers transport, movement, synthesis, and signaling.

### **Adenoviruses**

Adenoviruses are non-enveloped DNA viruses that can cause respiratory, eye, gastrointestinal, urinary, or other infections, usually self-limited but sometimes severe in vulnerable people.

### **Adiposis Dolorosa**

Adiposis dolorosa, or Dercum disease, is a rare disorder characterized by painful fatty deposits, often with obesity, fatigue, and other systemic symptoms.

### **Adoption**

In healthcare and genetics, adoption may be relevant to family history, consent, psychosocial care, and assessment when biological family information is unavailable or differs from the caregiving family.

### **Adrenocorticotrophic Hormone (ACTH)**

Adrenocorticotrophic hormone, or ACTH, is released by the pituitary and stimulates the adrenal cortex, especially cortisol production; abnormal levels help localize endocrine disease.

### **Advance Statements About Medical Treatment**

Advance statements about medical treatment record a person's preferences, values, and wishes for future care if illness later prevents effective communication; legal status varies by jurisdiction.

### **Adverse Reactions To Drugs**

Adverse drug reactions are harmful, unintended responses to medicines taken at normal doses, ranging from predictable side effects to allergic, organ-toxic, or idiosyncratic reactions.

### **AëDes Aegypti**

Aëdes aegypti, now usually written Aedes aegypti, is a mosquito that transmits dengue, yellow fever, chikungunya, Zika, and other viruses.

### **Aegophony**

Aegophony is an altered “E” sound heard through a stethoscope as an “A,” classically suggesting lung consolidation or fluid-related change when present over the chest.

### **Aerobic Bacterium**

An aerobic bacterium grows using oxygen, although some species can tolerate or use alternative metabolic pathways; oxygen requirements help guide culture and infection assessment.

### **Afibrinogenaemia**

Afibrinogenaemia is severe or complete deficiency of fibrinogen, an essential clotting protein, causing a bleeding tendency; it is usually inherited but may be acquired.

### **Agammaglobulinaemia**

Agammaglobulinaemia is profound deficiency of immunoglobulins and mature B cells, leading to recurrent bacterial infections; X-linked disease is a classic form.

### **Ageing**

Ageing is the progressive biological and functional change over time, including altered repair, immunity, metabolism, organ reserve, and susceptibility to disease.

### **Agglutinin**

An agglutinin is an antigen, often on a red blood cell, that can trigger production of a corresponding agglutinin and cause visible cell clumping in a compatible reaction.

### **AI**

In medicine, AI means artificial intelligence: computer methods that analyze data or recognize patterns to support research, diagnosis, prediction, treatment, or clinical workflow; they require validation and oversight.

### **Air Passages**

The air passages are the conducting airways from

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the nose and mouth through the pharynx, larynx, trachea, bronchi, and bronchioles; obstruction can impair ventilation.

### **Air-Sickness**

Air-sickness is motion sickness triggered by aircraft movement or conflicting visual and vestibular signals, causing nausea, dizziness, sweating, and sometimes vomiting.

### **Alastrim**

Alastrim is a historical name for a generally milder form of smallpox, caused by variola minor; smallpox has been eradicated worldwide.

### **Albendazole**

Albendazole is a benzimidazole antiparasitic drug that disrupts parasite microtubules and is used for several intestinal and tissue helminth infections.

### **Albumins**

Albumins are water-soluble proteins, especially serum albumin made by the liver, that maintain oncotic pressure and transport hormones, fatty acids, drugs, and other substances.

### **Alcuronium**

Alcuronium is a nondepolarizing neuromuscular-blocking drug that causes skeletal-muscle paralysis during anesthesia; it requires airway and respiratory support.

### **Alfacalcidol**

Alfacalcidol is a vitamin-D analogue converted in the liver to an active form that increases calcium and phosphate absorption and is used in selected bone and mineral disorders.

### **Alglucerase**

Alglucerase is a modified form of the lysosomal enzyme glucocerebrosidase formerly used as enzyme-replacement therapy for Gaucher disease; newer preparations are more commonly used.

### **Algorithm**

A medical algorithm is a defined sequence of rules or calculations used to support diagnosis, risk assessment, treatment, triage, or data analysis; it does not replace clinical judgment.

### **Alimentary Canal**

The alimentary canal is the continuous digestive tube from mouth to anus, including the pharynx, esophagus, stomach, small intestine, and large intestine.

### **Alkali**

An alkali is a basic substance that accepts hydrogen ions or produces hydroxide in solution; caustic alkalis can cause severe chemical burns, while controlled bases have medical and laboratory uses.

### **Alkaloids**

Alkaloids are nitrogen-containing plant or microbial compounds with diverse biologic effects; examples include morphine, quinine, nicotine, and atropine.

### **Alkylating Agents**

Alkylating agents are drugs or chemicals that add alkyl groups to DNA or other molecules; anticancer agents exploit this to inhibit replication, while normal-tissue toxicity includes myelosuppression and mutagenic risk.

### **Allantoin**

Allantoin is a compound used in some topical products for its skin-protective, moisturizing, and keratolytic properties; formulation and indication determine its clinical role.

### **Allantois**

The allantois is an embryonic membrane involved in early waste handling, blood-vessel development, and formation of structures related to the umbilicus and urinary bladder.

### **Azotaemia**

Azotaemia is excess nitrogen-containing waste, especially urea and creatinine, in the blood, usually

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reflecting reduced kidney filtration, increased production, or altered renal blood flow.

### **Acute Decompensated Heart Failure**

A rapid onset or worsening of heart-failure symptoms and signs caused by increased cardiac filling pressures and/or inadequate cardiac output. It commonly presents with breathlessness, pulmonary or systemic congestion, edema, or fatigue and requires prompt assessment for precipitating causes and urgent treatment when respiratory failure, hypotension, or organ dysfunction is present.

### **ANOCA**

Angina with non-obstructive coronary arteries: angina symptoms without a flow-limiting obstructive stenosis in the epicardial coronary arteries. Causes may include coronary microvascular dysfunction or vasospastic angina, and further evaluation can help identify the mechanism.

### **Appendageal**

Relating to skin appendages or structures derived from the skin, including hair follicles, sweat glands, and sebaceous glands.

### **Arciform**

Having a curved or arch-like shape, used to describe the configuration of a skin lesion, rash, or other anatomical finding.

### **Asymmetrical**

Unequal in shape, size, distribution, or appearance between corresponding sides; asymmetry of a pigmented lesion can be a warning feature requiring assessment.

### **Acute Febrile Illness (AFI)**

A sudden illness characterized by fever, often with headache, chills, muscle aches, gastrointestinal symptoms, or other signs of infection; the cause may be infectious or noninfectious.

### **Asymptomatic Carrier**

A person who harbors a pathogen and can poten-

tially transmit it despite having no symptoms of the associated infection.

### **Autosomal Recessive Polycystic Kidney Disease**

An inherited cystic kidney disorder, usually presenting in infancy or childhood, caused by pathogenic variants commonly affecting PKHD1; it may cause enlarged echogenic kidneys, impaired kidney function, liver fibrosis, and hypertension.

#### **Synonyms:**

ARPKD

### **ARPKD**

Alternate index label; see *Autosomal Recessive Polycystic Kidney Disease*.

### **ADPKD**

Alternate index label; see *Autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease*.

### **AKI**

Alternate index label; see *Acute Kidney Injury*.

### **Autosomal Recessive Disorders**

Disorders caused when a person inherits pathogenic variants in both copies of a gene, usually one from each parent; carriers with one altered copy are often unaffected.

### **Acute Exacerbation**

A rapid worsening of a chronic pulmonary condition, with increased breathlessness, cough, oxygen need, or other symptoms; infection, aspiration, embolism, and other triggers may contribute.

### **Amplified Musculoskeletal Pain Syndrome**

A chronic pain condition, often beginning in childhood or adolescence, in which pain is unusually intense or widespread and may be accompanied by sensitivity, fatigue, or functional limitation despite no single structural explanation; it is also called AMPS.

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### **Axial Spondyloarthritis**

An inflammatory rheumatic disease primarily affecting the sacroiliac joints and spine, causing chronic inflammatory back pain and stiffness; it includes radiographic and non-radiographic forms.

### **Advanced Sleep-Wake Phase Disorder**

A circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorder in which a person becomes sleepy and falls asleep earlier than desired and wakes earlier than desired; symptoms persist despite an opportunity for a preferred schedule.

### **Arousal Index**

The number of brief awakenings or arousals from sleep per hour of sleep, usually measured during polysomnography; an elevated value may indicate sleep fragmentation.

### **Anticholinergic Toxidrome**

A poisoning pattern caused by blockade of muscarinic acetylcholine receptors, commonly producing dry skin and mouth, dilated pupils, rapid heart rate, urinary retention, reduced bowel sounds, overheating, agitation, or delirium.

### **Augmentation Mammoplasty**

Surgical enlargement of the breasts using implants or, in selected procedures, transferred fat; risks, expected results, and suitability depend on anatomy and the chosen technique.

### **Atypical Fibroxanthoma**

A superficial, usually low-grade malignant fibrohistiocytic tumor of sun-damaged skin in older adults; it may resemble squamous-cell carcinoma or melanoma and is treated by complete excision.

### **Atypical Spitz Nevus**

A melanocytic proliferation with Spitz-like features and atypia that may resemble melanoma; diagnosis relies on clinicopathologic correlation and, when needed, expert histopathologic review.

### **Adenomyoepithelioma Of The Breast**

A rare biphasic breast tumor composed of proliferating epithelial and myoepithelial cells. Most are benign, but local recurrence and malignant transformation can occur, so complete excision is usually recommended.

### **Angiosarcoma Of The Breast**

A malignant vascular tumor of the breast that may arise primarily or, more rarely, after radiation or chronic lymphoedema. It often presents as an enlarging mass or bruise-like skin discoloration and requires oncologic management.

### **Appendiceal Adenocarcinoma**

A malignant gland-forming epithelial tumor of the appendix. It may present with appendicitis or be discovered incidentally, and its management depends on histologic type, grade, invasion, and peritoneal spread.

### **Anal Intraepithelial Neoplasia**

A premalignant squamous lesion of the anal canal or perianal skin, usually related to persistent high-risk HPV infection. It ranges from low- to high-grade disease and may progress to anal squamous cell carcinoma.

### **Anal Condyloma**

A benign wart-like squamous lesion of the anus or perianal skin, usually caused by low-risk HPV types. Multiple or recurrent lesions may coexist with high-grade intraepithelial neoplasia.

### **Angiosarcoma Of The Heart**

A rare aggressive primary cardiac sarcoma, most often arising in the right atrium and potentially causing obstruction, pericardial effusion, arrhythmia, or metastases. Diagnosis requires imaging and tissue evaluation.

### **Aggressive Angiomyxoma**

A locally infiltrative, usually slow-growing mesenchymal tumor of the pelvis and perineum, predominantly affecting reproductive-age women. It may be mistaken for a Bartholin cyst and has a tendency

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to recur.

### **Angiomyofibroblastoma**

A benign mesenchymal tumor of the vulvovaginal region, usually presenting as a small, well-circumscribed painless mass in reproductive-age or middle-aged women.

### **Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma Of The Vulva**

A rare malignant tumor of vulvar Bartholin-type glands, often causing pain because of perineural invasion. It is usually slow-growing but may recur locally or metastasize after long intervals.

### **Adenocarcinoma Of The Vulva, Clear Cell Type**

A rare vulvar glandular carcinoma with clear-cell morphology that may arise from Müllerian-type or other specialized vulvar glands; diagnosis requires immunohistochemical and clinical correlation.

### **Acute Coronary Syndromes**

A spectrum of acute myocardial ischemia comprising unstable angina, non-ST-elevation myocardial infarction, and ST-elevation myocardial infarction, usually caused by acute coronary plaque disruption and thrombosis.

### **Adolescent Medicine**

A medical specialty focused on the physical, mental, reproductive, and social health needs of adolescents and young adults, including prevention, risk behavior, chronic disease, and confidentiality-sensitive care.

### **Aesthetic Medicine**

Medical care intended to improve appearance or reduce visible signs of aging through procedures, devices, medicines, or skin care; appropriate assessment includes risks, contraindications, and realistic expectations.

### **Age-Related Macular Degeneration And Retinal Disease**

Age-related macular degeneration is a degenerative

disease of the macula causing central-vision loss; retinal diseases also include vascular, inflammatory, inherited, and tractional disorders requiring ophthalmic evaluation.

### **Alveolar Rhabdomyosarcoma**

A malignant small-round-cell tumor showing skeletal-muscle differentiation, usually arising in the extremities, trunk, or head and neck of children and adolescents. It may disseminate early through lymphatic and hematogenous routes and often carries characteristic PAX3-FOXO1 or PAX7-FOXO1 fusions. Diagnosis requires biopsy with immunophenotyping and molecular testing, followed by staging for local and distant disease. Treatment is multimodal and commonly includes systemic chemotherapy with surgery and/or radiotherapy according to risk group.

### **Ampullary Carcinoma**

A malignant epithelial tumor arising in or around the ampulla of Vater, where the bile duct and pancreatic duct enter the duodenum. It commonly presents with obstructive jaundice, abnormal liver tests, pancreatitis, or gastrointestinal bleeding. Histologic subtype and local extension influence prognosis, staging, and treatment selection. Diagnosis uses endoscopy, cross-sectional imaging, and tissue sampling, with surgery considered for resectable disease.

### **Aplastic Crisis**

An abrupt temporary cessation of red-cell production causing a rapid fall in hemoglobin and reticulocyte count. It most often follows Parvovirus B19 infection in people with shortened red-cell survival, such as those with sickle-cell disease or hereditary spherocytosis. Symptoms may include pallor, fatigue, tachycardia, and worsening anemia without the usual increase in reticulocytes. Diagnosis relies on blood counts, reticulocyte measurement, and targeted viral testing; treatment is supportive and directed at the underlying disorder.

### **Asymptomatic Adults**

Adults who report no symptoms attributable to the



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condition or disease being assessed. Asymptomatic status does not exclude subclinical disease, risk factors, or early pathology. Evaluation may involve history, examination, screening tests, or targeted investigations according to age, risk, and clinical guidelines. The term is used in screening, preventive medicine, epidemiology, and studies of disease detected before symptoms develop.



## B

### B Cell (B Lymphocyte)

A key cellular component of adaptive humoral immunity that matures in the bone marrow. Upon antigen recognition via B-cell receptor (BCR/surface IgM) and T-cell help (CD40/CD40L interaction), B cells proliferate and differentiate into antibody-secreting plasma cells and long-lived memory B cells.

#### Synonyms:

B Lymphocyte

### B Chromosome

A supernumerary chromosome that is not part of the standard chromosome complement and is not required for normal development. It may occur in certain plants, animals, or tumors and varies in number between cells.

### B-Cell Receptor

The membrane-bound immunoglobulin complex on a B lymphocyte that recognizes native antigen. BCR signaling, with appropriate co-stimulation, promotes B-cell activation, proliferation, differentiation, and antibody production.

### B-Lynch Suture

A surgical technique for controlling postpartum hemorrhage due to uterine atony unresponsive to medical management. A compressive suture placed around the uterus to mechanically compress the uterine walls and reduce blood flow. The suture creates a brace-like effect. Can be combined with other compression sutures (Cho, Hayman).

### Babesiosis

A tick-borne infection caused by *Babesia* parasites, commonly *B. microti* in the United States

and *B. divergens* in Europe. The parasites infect red blood cells and can cause fever, fatigue, haemolytic anaemia, thrombocytopenia, jaundice, and haemoglobinuria; severe disease is more likely in people without a spleen or with impaired immunity.

### Babinski Reflex

An extensor plantar response present from birth to approximately 2 years. When the lateral sole is stroked, the great toe dorsiflexes and other toes fan outward. Disappears as the corticospinal tract myelinates. Persistence beyond age 2 may indicate neurologic abnormality.

### Babinski Sign

The Babinski sign is a pathological reflex elicited by stroking the lateral aspect of the sole of the foot from the heel to the metatarsal heads with a blunt object. A normal response (flexor plantar response) is plantar flexion (curling downward) of all toes.

### Bacillary Angiomatosis

A vascular proliferative disease caused by *Bartonella henselae* or *B. quintana*, occurring in immunocompromised patients (HIV/AIDS, transplant). Presents with erythematous papules, nodules, or pedunculated lesions resembling Kaposi sarcoma or pyogenic granuloma. Can involve skin, liver (peliosis hepatis), spleen, bone, and lymph nodes.

### Bacilluria

The presence of bacilli in the urine, usually referring to rod-shaped bacteria detected by microscopy or culture. Its clinical significance depends on symptoms, quantitative culture, and the organism identified.

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## Back Injury

Damage to the muscles, ligaments, joints, discs, vertebrae, or nerves of the back caused by trauma, lifting, or repetitive strain. Pain and stiffness are common; weakness, numbness, loss of bladder or bowel control, or severe pain after major trauma requires urgent assessment.

## Back Pain

One of the most common medical complaints, affecting up to 80 percent of the population at some point in life, and the leading cause of disability worldwide. Back pain is classified by duration: acute (less than 4 weeks), subacute (4-12 weeks), and chronic (greater than 12 weeks).

### Synonyms:

Pain, Back

## Backache

Pain or discomfort located anywhere in the posterior trunk from neck to buttocks, a symptom rather than a disease. Causes include musculoskeletal strain (most common), disc herniation, spinal stenosis, facet arthropathy, sacroiliac joint dysfunction, and referred pain from renal, pancreatic, or vascular sources.

## Bacteremia

The presence of viable bacteria in the bloodstream, a serious condition that can be transient (after dental procedures, toothbrushing), intermittent (undrained abscess), or continuous (endovascular infection like endocarditis). Bacteremia triggers systemic inflammatory responses ranging from fever and leukocytosis to septic shock.

## Bacteria

Single-celled microscopic organisms lacking a nucleus, which can exist independently or in colonies; some are beneficial to health (microbiome) while others cause infectious disease.

## Bacterial Adherence

The process by which bacteria attach to host cell surfaces, a critical first step in colonisation and infection. Adherence is mediated by adhesins, which

are surface structures that bind to specific receptors on host cells. Adhesins include pili, fimbriae, outer membrane proteins, and capsules.

## Bacterial Biofilms

Structured communities of bacteria attached to surfaces and embedded in a self-produced matrix of extracellular polymeric substances. Biofilms are a major cause of chronic infections, particularly on medical devices including catheters, prosthetic joints, and heart valves.

## Bacterial Capsule

A polysaccharide layer surrounding the bacterial cell wall that protects against phagocytosis and complement-mediated killing. Capsules are major virulence factors for many pathogens including *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, *Haemophilus influenzae*, and *Klebsiella pneumoniae*.

## Bacterial Cell Wall

The rigid outer layer of bacteria that provides structural integrity and determines cell shape. The cell wall is composed primarily of peptidoglycan, a polymer of sugars cross-linked by short peptides.

## Bacterial Classification

The organisation of bacteria into taxonomic groups based on genetic, phenotypic, and evolutionary relationships. Bacteria are classified using a hierarchical system: domain, phylum, class, order, family, genus, and species.

## Bacterial Conjugation

The transfer of genetic material between bacteria through direct cell-to-cell contact via a pilus. Conjugation is mediated by conjugative plasmids that encode the genes for transfer. The donor cell (F+) forms a conjugative pilus that attaches to the recipient cell (F-).

## Bacterial Conjunctivitis

An infection of the conjunctival mucous membrane caused by various bacterial pathogens, presenting with a purulent or mucopurulent discharge that causes the eyelids to become matted together, par-

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ticularly upon waking, conjunctival injection, and a gritty or foreign body sensation.

### **Bacterial Dermatitis**

Inflammation of the skin caused by bacterial infection, typically presenting with erythema, edema, warmth, pain, and purulent discharge. Common causative organisms include *Staphylococcus aureus* and *Streptococcus pyogenes*, and the condition may arise de novo or as a superinfection of pre-existing dermatitis.

### **Bacterial Dormancy**

A state of reduced metabolic activity that allows bacteria to survive unfavourable conditions. Dormant forms include spores, persisters, and viable but non-culturable cells. Spores are highly resistant structures formed by *Bacillus* and *Clostridium*. Persisters are phenotypic variants that are tolerant to antibiotics.

### **Bacterial Endocarditis**

Infection of the heart's inner lining or valves by bacteria, usually producing fever and a new or changing heart murmur. It can cause valve damage and embolic complications.

### **Bacterial Endocarditis Vegetations**

Vegetations in bacterial endocarditis are complex masses composed of bacteria, fibrin, and platelets that form on heart valve surfaces or endocardium. The pathogenesis begins with bacteremia seeding a site of endothelial damage or a previously abnormal valve surface.

### **Bacterial Endospores**

Highly resistant dormant structures formed by certain gram-positive bacteria including *Bacillus* and *Clostridium* species. Endospores form during nutrient deprivation and can survive for decades. They are resistant to heat, radiation, chemicals, and desiccation.

### **Bacterial Flagella**

Thread-like appendages composed of flagellin protein that provide motility to bacteria. Flagella are

composed of three parts: the filament, hook, and basal body. The basal body is embedded in the cell wall and functions as a rotary motor.

### **Bacterial Gastroenteritis**

Acute inflammation of the stomach and intestines caused by pathogenic bacteria such as *Salmonella*, *Campylobacter*, *Shigella*, or pathogenic *Escherichia coli*. It commonly causes diarrhea, abdominal cramps, fever, and sometimes bloody stools or vomiting.

### **Bacterial Genetics**

The study of genes and genetic processes in bacteria. Bacteria have a single circular chromosome and may contain plasmids, which are extrachromosomal DNA elements. Bacterial genes are organized into operons, which are clusters of genes regulated as a unit.

### **Bacterial Growth Phases**

The stages of bacterial growth in culture. The lag phase is when bacteria adapt to their environment. The log (exponential) phase is when bacteria multiply at their maximum rate. The stationary phase is when nutrient depletion and waste accumulation limit growth. The death phase is when bacteria die.

### **Bacterial Infections**

Illnesses caused by pathogenic bacteria proliferating in the body, ranging from mild sore throats and ear infections to life-threatening sepsis and meningitis. They are diagnosed through cultures, PCR testing, or other microbiological methods.

### **Bacterial Meningitis**

Infection of the meninges by bacteria, a medical emergency. In neonates: Group B *Streptococcus*, *E. coli*, *Listeria*. In older children: *Neisseria meningitidis*, *Streptococcus pneumoniae*. Presents with fever, headache, neck stiffness, altered consciousness, and Kernig/Brudzinski signs.

### **Bacterial Metabolism**

The chemical processes that occur within bacteria to maintain life. Bacteria have diverse metabolic

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capabilities including aerobic and anaerobic respiration, fermentation, and photosynthesis. Metabolic pathways are targets for antimicrobial drugs.

### **Bacterial Morphology**

The shape and arrangement of bacteria as observed under microscopy. Basic shapes include cocci (spheres), bacilli (rods), and spirilla (spirals). Cocci can be arranged in pairs (diplococci), chains (streptococci), clusters (staphylococci), or tetrads. Bacilli can be single, paired, or arranged in chains.

### **Bacterial Overgrowth**

Excessive proliferation of bacteria in the small intestine, commonly called small-intestinal bacterial overgrowth. It may result from impaired intestinal motility, anatomical stasis, blind loops, strictures, diverticula, or loss of the normal ileocaecal barrier.

#### **Synonyms:**

small-intestinal bacterial overgrowth.

### **Bacterial Pathogenesis**

The mechanisms by which bacteria cause disease. Pathogenesis involves adhesion, invasion, toxin production, and immune evasion. Adhesins mediate attachment to host cells. Invasins allow penetration of tissues. Toxins damage host cells.

### **Bacterial Pili**

Hair-like appendages on the bacterial surface composed of pilin protein. Pili are shorter and thicker than flagella. Type I pili mediate adherence to host cells and are important virulence factors. Type IV pili are involved in twitching motility and DNA uptake during transformation.

### **Bacterial Pneumonia**

Infection of the lung tissue by bacteria, causing inflammation and air-space filling. It may cause fever, cough, sputum, chest pain, and shortness of breath.

### **Bacterial Spore**

A metabolically dormant, highly resistant structure produced by certain bacteria, notably *Bacillus* and *Clostridioides* species, in response to environmental

stress. Spores resist desiccation, heat, and many disinfectants and require validated sterilization for reliable destruction.

### **Bacterial Toxins**

Substances produced by bacteria that cause damage to host cells. There are two major categories: exotoxins and endotoxins. Exotoxins are proteins secreted by bacteria that have specific toxic effects. Endotoxins are lipopolysaccharide components of gram-negative bacterial outer membranes released during cell lysis.

### **Bacterial Tracheitis**

Bacterial infection and inflammation of the trachea, often causing fever, a harsh cough, noisy breathing, and potentially rapid airway obstruction.

### **Bacterial Transduction**

The transfer of bacterial DNA from one bacterium to another through bacteriophages (bacterial viruses).

### **Bacterial Transformation**

The uptake of free DNA from the environment by competent bacteria. Transformation occurs naturally in some bacterial species including *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, *Haemophilus influenzae*, and *Neisseria*. Competence is the ability to take up DNA and is regulated by specific genes.

### **Bacterial Vaginosis**

BV: replacement of normal vaginal lactobacilli by an overgrowth of mixed anaerobes (*Gardnerella vaginalis*, *Mobiluncus*, etc.), the most common cause of vaginal discharge in reproductive-age women. Risk: new/multiple partners, douching, smoking.

### **Bacterial Virulence Factors**

Molecules produced by bacteria that contribute to their ability to cause disease. Virulence factors include adhesins, invasins, toxins, capsules, and enzymes. Adhesins mediate attachment to host cells. Toxins damage host cells directly. Capsules protect against phagocytosis.



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## **Bactericide**

An agent that kills bacteria rather than merely inhibiting their growth (bacteriostatic). Bactericidal antibiotics include beta-lactams (penicillins, cephalosporins, carbapenems), aminoglycosides, fluoroquinolones, metronidazole, and vancomycin.

## **Bacteriology**

The branch of microbiology concerned with the study of bacteria, including their morphology, genetics, physiology, ecology, and clinical significance.

## **Bacteriophage**

A virus that infects and replicates within bacteria.

## **Bacteriophage Therapy**

The investigational use of bacteriophages, viruses that infect bacteria, to treat selected bacterial infections. Their activity is usually limited to susceptible bacterial strains.

## **Bacterium**

A unicellular prokaryote lacking a nucleus and membrane-bound organelles, possessing a single circular chromosome and typically a peptidoglycan cell wall.

## **Bacteriuria**

The presence of bacteria in urine, detected by urinalysis or culture. It may occur with urinary symptoms, as in a urinary-tract infection, or without symptoms, as in asymptomatic bacteriuria; interpretation depends on specimen quality, bacterial quantity, patient context, and the presence of inflammation or symptoms.

## **Bag-Mask Ventilation**

Manual ventilation of a non-breathing or inadequately breathing patient using a self-inflating bag (AMBU) attached to a mask sealed over the face. Effective technique: correct mask size, jaw thrust/head extension, two-person technique (two-hand seal), adequate tidal volumes with ETCO<sub>2</sub> monitoring.

## **Bagassosis**

An occupational hypersensitivity pneumonitis (extrinsic allergic alveolitis) caused by inhalation of dust from moldy bagasse—the fibrous residue of sugarcane after extraction. Caused by thermophilic actinomycetes (*Saccharopolyspora rectivirgula*) that colonize stored bagasse.

## **Bainbridge Reflex**

An increase in heart rate produced by stretch of the atrial walls, especially during increased venous return. The reflex helps limit venous congestion by adjusting cardiac output.

## **Baker Cyst**

A fluid-filled cyst in the popliteal fossa, resulting from herniation of the synovial membrane through the posterior knee joint capsule or from a communication between the knee joint and the gastrocnemius-semimembranosus bursa.

### **Synonyms:**

Bakers Cyst (Baker Cyst) Popliteal Cyst (Baker Cyst)

## **Baker's Cyst**

A fluid-filled synovial cyst arising from the gastrocnemius-semimembranosus bursa posterior to the knee, typically caused by chronic knee joint effusion from conditions such as osteoarthritis, rheumatoid arthritis, or meniscal tears. It presents as a palpable, tender mass in the popliteal fossa that may rupture causing calf swelling.

## **Balamuthia Mandrillaris Infection**

A rare, usually fatal infection caused by the free-living amoeba *Balamuthia mandrillaris*. It may begin as a skin lesion and progress to granulomatous amoebic encephalitis with headache, confusion, seizures, or focal neurologic deficits. Diagnosis is difficult and requires specialized testing; urgent infectious-disease and neurologic evaluation is essential.

## **Balance**

The ability to maintain the body's center of mass over its base of support, relying on input from the

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vestibular system, vision, and proprioception. It is essential for walking, standing, and performing daily activities without falling. Age-related decline, medications, and neurological disorders can impair balance, increasing fall risk.

### **Balance Assessment**

An evaluation of steadiness and the ability to maintain safe posture during standing and movement. It may include standardized tests and helps identify mobility or fall risk.

### **Balance Disorders And Vertigo**

Balance disorders encompass conditions that cause dizziness, unsteadiness, or a sensation of motion, often arising from dysfunction in the inner ear, brain, or sensory pathways.

### **Balance Impairment**

The ability to maintain the body's center of mass over its base of support, relying on input from the vestibular system, vision, and proprioception. See balance.

### **Balance Training**

Exercises improving postural stability and preventing falls. Components: static balance, dynamic balance, reactive balance. Techniques: weight shifting, tandem stance, single-leg stance, perturbations, balance boards. Essential for elderly, neurological conditions.

### **Balanitis**

Inflammation of the glans penis, often involving the prepuce (balanoposthitis). Causes include poor hygiene, irritants, infection, and dermatologic conditions such as lichen planus, psoriasis, and lichen sclerosus. It may cause erythema, swelling, discharge, pruritus, and discomfort; treatment depends on the cause.

### **Balanoposthitis**

Inflammation of both the glans penis and the prepuce. It may cause pain, erythema, swelling, discharge, or difficulty retracting the foreskin and can result from infection, irritation, or inflammatory

skin disease.

### **Baldness**

Commonly used term for substantial hair loss, especially androgenetic alopecia, also called pattern hair loss. In this condition, genetically susceptible hair follicles gradually become smaller under the influence of androgens.

**Synonyms:**  
pattern.

### **Ballard Score**

Clinical assessment of gestational age in newborns using 6 physical and 6 neuromuscular maturity criteria. Physical parameters: skin texture, ear form and recoil, eye appearance, breast tissue, and genitalia. Neuromuscular: posture, arm and leg recoil, popliteal angle, scarf sign, and heel-to-ear.

### **Ballism**

A hyperkinetic movement disorder characterized by sudden, involuntary, large-amplitude, flinging movements of a limb or limbs. It is often related to dysfunction of the subthalamic region or connected basal-ganglia circuits.

### **Ballistocardiography**

The graphic recording of repetitive body movements produced by the ejection of blood with each heart-beat. It has been used to study cardiac mechanical activity and circulation.

### **Balloon (Vascular)**

An inflatable catheter component used to widen a narrowed blood vessel or expand a vascular stent.

**Synonyms:**  
Vascular

### **Balloon Aortic Valvuloplasty**

Catheter-based procedure using balloon inflation to dilate a stenotic aortic valve. Provides temporary hemodynamic improvement in severe AS but restenosis is common within 6-12 months. Used as a bridge to TAVR or surgical AVR in hemodynamically unstable patients, or as palliation in patients

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not eligible for definitive valve replacement.

### **Balloon Catheter**

A catheter with an inflatable tip used to widen a narrowed vessel, expand a stent, or dilate another body passage.

### **Band Keratopathy**

A horizontal band of calcium deposition in the superficial cornea, typically across the interpalpebral area. It may occur with chronic ocular inflammation, hypercalcemia, renal disease, or longstanding eye disease and can impair vision.

### **Bandage**

Material applied to cover, protect, compress, or support an injured body part. Examples include gauze, adhesive, elastic, and tubular bandages.

### **Bandage Scissors**

Blunt-tipped scissors for cutting bandages.

### **Bankart Lesion**

A tear of the anterior-inferior glenoid labrum, usually caused by anterior shoulder dislocation and associated with recurrent instability.

### **Bannayan-Riley-Ruvalcaba Syndrome**

Autosomal dominant PTEN hamartoma tumor syndrome (PHTS) caused by loss-of-function mutations in PTEN (10q23), allelic to Cowden syndrome.

### **Banti Disease**

A historical term for congestive splenomegaly associated with portal hypertension and hypersplenism. Modern evaluation usually identifies the underlying hepatic, portal-venous, or hematologic cause.

### **Banti Syndrome**

A historical term for portal hypertension with splenomegaly and hypersplenism. Modern evaluation usually identifies an underlying hepatic, portal-venous, or hematologic disorder.

### **Barbiturate**

A class of CNS depressants derived from barbituric acid that enhance GABA-A receptor activity by increasing the duration of chloride channel opening (as opposed to benzodiazepines, which increase the frequency). At low doses: anxiolysis and sedation. At moderate doses: hypnosis and anesthesia.

### **Bare Stent (Vascular)**

A metal mesh tube placed inside a narrowed vessel without a drug coating to keep the vessel open.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Bariatric Surgery**

Weight loss procedures and surgery, collectively known as bariatric surgery, are invasive interventions for severe obesity that produce substantial and sustained weight loss by altering gastrointestinal anatomy and physiology.

### **Barium**

A metallic element (atomic number 56, symbol Ba) whose sulfate salt (barium sulfate) is used as a radiopaque agent due to its high atomic number, which effectively absorbs X-rays.

### **Barium Enema**

Fluoroscopic imaging of the large intestine after retrograde filling with barium contrast. Double-contrast (barium + air) provides better mucosal detail. Indications: colorectal cancer screening (historical, now CT colonography preferred), evaluation of colonic obstruction, diverticulosis, and postsurgical anatomy.

### **Barium Study**

X-ray imaging using barium sulfate contrast. Barium swallow, barium enema, upper GI series. Evaluates GI tract morphology and function.

### **Barium Swallow**

Fluoroscopic examination of the esophagus after ingestion of barium contrast. Used to evaluate esophageal anatomy, motility, strictures, and struc-

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tural abnormalities. The study demonstrates mucosal detail, filling defects, strictures, and motility disorders. A barium follow-through extends the examination to the small bowel.

### **Barium-133**

Calibration source. Half-life 10.5 years. Used for energy calibration.

### **Barognosis**

The ability to recognize and distinguish the weight of objects by handling them, with intact primary sensation. Impaired barognosis indicates a cortical sensory deficit.

### **Baroreceptor Reflex**

The rapid neural mechanism for short-term blood pressure regulation, involving baroreceptors (mechanoreceptors) in the carotid sinus (innervated by CN IX) and aortic arch (innervated by CN X). When blood pressure rises, baroreceptors increase their firing rate, signaling the cardiovascular center in the medulla.

### **Bouchard Nodes**

Bony enlargements of the proximal interphalangeal joints, usually associated with osteoarthritis.

### **Buffy Coat**

The thin layer of white blood cells and platelets that forms between plasma and red blood cells after centrifugation of whole blood.

### **Barotrauma**

Lung injury from excessive pressure during ventilation, causing alveolar rupture (pneumothorax, pneumomediastinum). Risk factors: high pressures, high PEEP. Prevented by lung-protective ventilation.

### **Barrel Chest**

A rounded, enlarged appearance of the chest caused by increased lung volume or changes in the chest wall. It may occur with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, severe asthma, or other long-standing lung conditions.

### **Barrett Esophagus**

Metaplastic transformation of the normal stratified squamous epithelium of the distal esophagus to specialized intestinal-type columnar epithelium containing goblet cells, occurring as a consequence of chronic gastroesophageal reflux disease.

### **Barrett Esophagus Surveillance**

Periodic endoscopic evaluation of Barrett esophagus to detect dysplasia or early esophageal adenocarcinoma. The interval and biopsy protocol depend on the presence and grade of dysplasia and current clinical guidelines.

### **Barrier Creams**

Topical preparations applied to the skin to create a physical protective layer against irritants, moisture, and pathogens. Common formulations include zinc oxide, petrolatum, dimethicone, and titanium dioxide.

### **Barthel Index**

A standardized scale that measures assistance needed for activities of daily living, including feeding, bathing, dressing, toileting, transfers, mobility, and stair use. Scores are interpreted according to the version of the scale and the clinical setting.

### **Bartholin Cyst**

A cyst of the Bartholin gland (paired mucus-secreting glands at the posterolateral introitus) due to obstruction of the duct; if infected, a Bartholin abscess.

### **Bartholin Gland**

One of two small glands near the vaginal opening that produce lubricating mucus. Blockage of its duct can cause a painless cyst; infection can produce a painful abscess with swelling, redness, and difficulty walking or sitting. Recurrent or atypical masses require gynecologic assessment.

### **Bartonellosis**

A group of infections caused by Bartonella species, including cat-scratch disease, bacillary angiomatosis, and, in some regions, bloodstream infection with

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fever and anemia. The clinical features depend on the species and the patient's immune status.

### **Bartter Syndrome**

Inherited autosomal recessive disorder of the thick ascending limb of the loop of Henle causing salt wasting, hypokalemic metabolic alkalosis, and hypercalciuria. Results from mutations in genes encoding the NKCC2 transporter or its regulatory subunits. Presents in childhood with failure to thrive, polyuria, and polydipsia.

### **Basal Cell Carcinoma**

The most common malignant skin tumor, arising from basal keratinocyte-lineage cells and associated with cumulative ultraviolet exposure and Hedgehog-pathway abnormalities. It commonly presents as a pearly papule or nodule with telangiectasia, ulceration, or a rolled border.

### **Basal Ganglia**

Deep gray matter nuclei in the cerebral hemispheres for motor control, cognition, and emotion. Key structures: caudate nucleus, putamen, globus pallidus (internal/external segments), subthalamic nucleus, substantia nigra. Direct pathway facilitates movement; indirect inhibits it.

### **Basal Ganglia Dysfunction**

Abnormal function of the deep cerebral nuclei that regulate movement, cognition, and procedural learning. It may cause tremor, rigidity, bradykinesia, chorea, dystonia, or abnormal involuntary movements, as in Parkinson disease and Huntington disease.

### **Basal Metabolic Rate**

Energy expenditure at rest for basic physiological functions. Accounts for 60-75% of total energy expenditure. Affected by age, sex, body composition, thyroid status, genetics. Measured by indirect calorimetry.

### **Base**

A substance that accepts protons ( $H^+$ ) or donates electron pairs (Lewis base). In aqueous solution,

bases increase  $OH^-$  concentration ( $pH > 7$ ). Strong bases ( $NaOH$ ,  $KOH$ ) dissociate completely; weak bases ( $NH_3$ ,  $HCO_3^-$ , protein side chains) partially.

### **Base Excision Repair**

The repair pathway for small, non-helix-distorting base lesions including oxidized bases (8-oxoguanine), deaminated bases (uracil from cytosine deamination), alkylated bases, and abasic (AP) sites.

### **Basement Membrane**

A thin, delicate layer of extracellular matrix that anchors epithelial tissue to the underlying connective tissue.

### **Basic Life Support**

Immediate care for a person with cardiac arrest or respiratory failure, including recognition, emergency activation, chest compressions, ventilation, and defibrillation when indicated.

### **Basic Metabolic Panel**

A panel of blood tests measuring serum glucose, sodium, potassium, chloride, bicarbonate, BUN, and creatinine. Also includes calcium in some institutions. Uses: assess hydration status, renal function, acid-base balance, and glucose control.

### **Basic Reproduction Number**

The expected number of secondary infections generated by one typical infectious person in a completely susceptible population, under specified conditions. It is a population and context parameter, not a fixed biological constant.

### **Basilar Artery Aneurysm**

Dilation of the basilar artery, most commonly fusiform, often associated with atherosclerosis or hypertension. May compress cranial nerves or brainstem structures causing facial pain, double vision, or hemiparesis. Rupture causes subarachnoid hemorrhage with high morbidity.

### **Basophil**

A rare ( $< 1$  percent of leukocytes) granulocyte with



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large, basophilic granules containing histamine, heparin, and leukotrienes. Basophils bear high-affinity IgE receptors (Fc-epsilon-RI) and, like mast cells, release histamine and mediators during immediate hypersensitivity (allergic) reactions.

### **Bath Salts Abuse And Addiction**

Misuse of synthetic cathinones, stimulant drugs that may cause agitation, paranoia, hallucinations, seizures, dangerously high temperature, cardiovascular complications, and dependence. Severe agitation, chest pain, seizure, hyperthermia, or altered consciousness requires emergency care. Treatment is supportive and may require addiction and mental-health services.

### **Battered Child Syndrome**

A pattern of repeated, non-accidental physical injury inflicted on a child by a caregiver, formally described by Kempe in 1962. Features include fractures of differing ages, subdural and retinal hemorrhages, inconsistent histories, and delayed presentation; mandatory reporting is required in most jurisdictions.

### **Bauhin Valve**

The ileocecal valve, a mucosal sphincter at the junction of the terminal ileum and cecum that helps regulate passage of intestinal contents and limits reflux from the colon.

### **BCG Vaccine**

A live attenuated vaccine derived from *Mycobacterium bovis* that helps prevent severe forms of tuberculosis, especially in children. Its use depends on national tuberculosis-risk policies.

### **Beals Syndrome**

A congenital connective-tissue disorder characterized by congenital contractures, arachnodactyly, kyphoscoliosis, and crumpled ears. It is usually associated with pathogenic variants affecting fibrillin-2.

### **Beam Hardening Artifact**

CT artifact from dense structures. Reduced by beam hardening correction algorithms.

### **Beau Lines**

Transverse depressions or grooves across the nail plate caused by temporary interruption of nail-matrix growth. They may follow severe illness, fever, trauma, malnutrition, chemotherapy, or systemic inflammatory disease.

### **Beau's Lines**

Transverse grooves or depressions across a fingernail or toenail caused by temporary interruption of nail-matrix growth. They may follow severe illness, injury, high fever, nutritional stress, or local trauma; the timing of the groove can help estimate when the event occurred.

### **Bechterew Disease**

Historical eponym for ankylosing spondylitis (also known as Marie-Strümpell disease), describing the chronic inflammatory arthritis of the axial skeleton first reported by Vladimir Bekhterev (Russian, 1892) and Adolf Strümpell (German, 1884).

#### **Synonyms:**

Marie-Strümpell disease),.

### **Beck Triad**

Classic diagnostic clinical triad of Cardiac Tamponade: (1) Hypotension, (2) Distended neck veins (elevated JVP), and (3) Muffled / distant heart sounds. See Cardiac Tamponade.

### **Becker Muscular Dystrophy**

An X-linked recessive neuromuscular disorder caused by mutations in the dystrophin gene, similar to Duchenne muscular dystrophy (DMD), but with in-frame mutations that allow production of some functional dystrophin protein, albeit reduced in quantity or abnormal in size. The result is a milder clinical phenotype compared to DMD.

### **Becker's Nevus**

A benign hamartomatous lesion appearing as a unilateral, hyperpigmented, often hairy patch, typically developing in adolescence on the shoulder or upper trunk of males. It results from a localized androgen-dependent increase in dermal smooth muscle and pigmentation. It is cosmetically concerning but



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carries no malignant potential.

### **Beckwith-Wiedemann Syndrome**

An overgrowth disorder associated with 11p15.5 imprinting defects. Features: macrosomia, macroglossia, omphalocele, visceromegaly, and neonatal hypoglycemia. Increased risk of embryonal tumors (Wilms tumor, hepatoblastoma).

### **Becquerel (Bq)**

The SI unit of radioactive activity, equal to one nuclear transformation per second. Administered activity is commonly reported in megabecquerels or gigabecquerels in nuclear medicine.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bq

### **Bedbug Bites**

Cutaneous reactions to bites of *Cimex lectularius* (bedbugs), nocturnal blood-feeding insects. Bites are painless but cause erythematous, pruritic papules, often in a linear arrangement (breakfast, lunch, dinner sign) or clusters on exposed skin (face, neck, arms, hands). Delayed hypersensitivity develops over days.

### **Bedpan**

A receptacle used by a person who cannot safely leave bed to urinate or pass stool.

### **Bedsore**

Pressure ulcer (decubitus): localized skin/soft tissue injury from prolonged pressure over bony prominences (sacrum, heels, occiput, trochanters), usually in immobile patients.

### **Bedwetting**

Involuntary urination during sleep after the age at which nighttime bladder control is usually established. It may be primary or secondary to urinary infection, constipation, diabetes, sleep disorders, stress, or other medical conditions and should be assessed when persistent, new, or accompanied by daytime symptoms.

### **Beers Criteria**

A regularly updated list of medicines that may pose increased risks for some older adults. It supports medication review but does not replace individualized clinical judgment.

### **Behavioral Rehabilitation**

Behavioral interventions for chronic conditions: pain management, addiction, adjustment.

### **Behcet Disease**

A chronic, relapsing systemic vasculitis characterized by recurrent oral ulcers, genital ulcers, and ocular inflammation, with a distribution along the ancient Silk Road from the Mediterranean to East Asia.

### **Belching**

The release of swallowed air or gas from the stomach through the mouth. Frequent belching may occur with aerophagia, gastroesophageal reflux, functional dyspepsia, or carbonated-drink consumption.

### **Bell Palsy**

Acute, idiopathic, unilateral facial nerve (CN VII) paralysis of lower motor neuron type, with an incidence of approximately 20-30 per 100,000 person-years.

### **Bell's Palsy**

Acute peripheral facial-nerve weakness of uncertain cause, usually affecting one side of the face. Eye protection and timely clinical assessment are important; treatment is individualized.

#### **Synonyms:**

Palsy, Bell's Palsy, Facial

### **Bence Jones Protein**

Monoclonal immunoglobulin light chains (free kappa or lambda) detectable in urine of patients with monoclonal gammopathies, most characteristically multiple myeloma but also Waldenstrom macroglobulinemia, MGUS, and primary amyloidosis (AL).

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### **Bence-Jones Protein**

A monoclonal immunoglobulin light chain found in urine or blood, classically associated with plasma-cell disorders such as multiple myeloma. Detection contributes to evaluation of monoclonal gammopathy and kidney injury.

### **Bends**

A manifestation of decompression sickness caused by gas bubbles forming in tissues or blood after a rapid reduction in ambient pressure. It commonly produces deep joint or muscle pain but may also involve the nervous system or lungs.

### **Beneficence And Non-Maleficence**

Core biomedical ethical principles guiding clinical practice and medical research. Beneficence requires healthcare providers to act in the best interest of the patient, taking positive steps to promote health, prevent harm, and relieve suffering.

### **Benign Intracranial Hypertension**

An older term for idiopathic intracranial hypertension, a disorder of raised intracranial pressure without an intracranial mass or hydrocephalus. Headache and papilledema are typical, and untreated disease may threaten vision.

### **Benign Mixed Tumor**

A benign salivary-gland tumor containing epithelial and connective-tissue components, usually called a pleomorphic adenoma.

### **Benign Neoplasm**

Benign neoplasms are proliferations of cells that remain confined to their site of origin, grow by expansion rather than invasion, and do not metastasize to distant sites. They typically grow slowly, pushing aside adjacent normal tissue and often becoming enclosed by a fibrous pseudocapsule formed from compressed connective tissue.

### **Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo**

A common peripheral vertigo from dislodged otoconia (canalithiasis) within the semicircular canals, most often the posterior canal. Brief episodes of ro-

tational vertigo lasting under one minute provoked by changes in head position.

### **Benign Positional Vertigo**

Brief episodes of spinning dizziness triggered by changes in head position, usually caused by displaced calcium carbonate crystals in a semicircular canal. It is also called benign paroxysmal positional vertigo or BPPV.

### **Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia**

Noncancerous enlargement of the prostate that may obstruct urine flow and cause hesitancy, weak stream, urgency, frequency, nocturia, or incomplete emptying. Assessment uses the symptoms, examination, and selected tests.

#### **Synonyms:**

BPH (Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia)

### **Benign Prostatic Obstruction**

Bladder-outlet obstruction caused by benign prostatic enlargement or increased prostatic smooth-muscle tone. It can produce weak stream, hesitancy, intermittency, straining, incomplete emptying, retention, infection, and upper-tract deterioration.

### **Benign Tumor**

Non-cancerous growth, slow-growing, well-differentiated, localized, does not invade or metastasize. Examples: lipoma, fibroma, adenoma. May cause problems by compression or hormone secretion.

### **Bent Spine Syndrome**

A marked, usually reducible forward flexion of the trunk caused by weakness or abnormal contraction of axial extensor muscles. It is also called camptocormia and may accompany neuromuscular or movement disorders.

#### **Synonyms:**

camptocormia and may accompany.

### **Benzene**

Solvent, industrial chemical. Chronic exposure: aplastic anemia, leukemia (especially AML). Acute:

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CNS depression, arrhythmias. Prevention: substitution, ventilation, monitoring.

### **Benzo(A)Pyrene**

Polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbon from combustion. Carcinogenic (lung, skin cancer). Found in tobacco smoke, charred meat, air pollution.

#### **Synonyms:**

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### **Benzodiazepine Use Disorder**

A problematic pattern of benzodiazepine use leading to significant impairment. Benzodiazepines include alprazolam, clonazepam, diazepam, and lorazepam. Dependence can develop rapidly with regular use. Withdrawal can be life-threatening, presenting with anxiety, insomnia, tremor, seizures, and psychosis.

### **Benzodiazepine Withdrawal**

Symptoms from cessation or reduction of prolonged benzodiazepine use. Early symptoms include anxiety, insomnia, tremor, and diaphoresis. Severe withdrawal can include seizures, psychosis, and delirium. Withdrawal severity depends on the half-life of the benzodiazepine, duration of use, and dose.

### **Benzodiazepines**

A class of drugs that enhance the effect of the inhibitory neurotransmitter gamma-aminobutyric acid at the GABA-A receptor, increasing the frequency of chloride channel opening and producing anxiolytic, sedative, anticonvulsant, and muscle relaxant effects.

### **Bereavement**

Natural grief response to the death of a loved one, marked by sadness, yearning, and preoccupation with the deceased, experienced in waves that diminish over weeks to months with preserved self-esteem. Distinct from major depression by its wave-like quality and preserved self-worth.

### **Bereavement Reaction**

A normal emotional response to the death of a loved one, involving grief that generally follows a variable course without necessarily indicating a mental dis-

order.

### **Berger Disease**

Historical name for IgA nephropathy named after Jean Berger who first characterized mesangial IgA deposition in 1968. Characterized by recurrent gross hematuria triggered by mucosal infections with intervals of microscopic hematuria and proteinuria. Generally benign course in most patients but subset progresses to CKD.

### **Beriberi**

A nutritional deficiency disease caused by inadequate thiamine (vitamin B1), occurring in two forms. Wet beriberi presents with high-output heart failure, peripheral vasodilation, edema, and tachycardia due to impaired cardiac energy metabolism.

### **Bernard–Soulier Syndrome**

An inherited platelet-adhesion disorder caused by deficiency or dysfunction of the glycoprotein Ib-IX-V complex, producing mucocutaneous bleeding and giant platelets.

### **Berry Aneurysm**

A small, rounded saccular aneurysm arising at an arterial branch point in the circle of Willis. Rupture is a major cause of nontraumatic subarachnoid hemorrhage.

### **Berylliosis**

A granulomatous lung disease from beryllium exposure. Chronic berylliosis resembles sarcoidosis. Diagnosis requires beryllium lymphocyte proliferation test.

### **Beta Blockers**

A class of medications that block the effects of adrenaline on the body's beta receptors. They slow down the heart rate and reduce blood pressure, making them widely used for treating heart conditions, high blood pressure, and anxiety.

### **Beta-Adrenergic Blocker**

A drug that antagonizes beta-adrenergic receptors,

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reducing heart rate, myocardial contractility, and renin release. It is used in selected patients with hypertension, angina, arrhythmias, post-myocardial infarction disease, and heart failure; abrupt withdrawal may worsen ischemia.

### **Beta-Blocker Overdose**

Toxic exposure to a beta-adrenergic blocker that may cause slow heart rate, low blood pressure, low blood glucose, bronchospasm, seizures, or altered consciousness. It requires urgent poison-control and medical management.

### **Beta-Blockers**

Beta-adrenergic blocking agents, commonly known as beta-blockers, are topical medications used in the treatment of glaucoma that lower intraocular pressure by reducing the production of aqueous humor by the ciliary body, primarily through blockade of beta-2 adrenergic receptors.

### **Beta-Lactam Antibiotics**

A large class of antimicrobial agents characterized by a beta-lactam ring in their molecular structure, which is essential for their bactericidal activity.

### **Beta-Lactamase Inhibitor Combinations**

Combinations of beta-lactam antibiotics with beta-lactamase inhibitors that extend activity against beta-lactamase producing organisms. The major combinations include amoxicillin-clavulanate, ampicillin-sulbactam, piperacillin-tazobactam, cefoperazone-sulbactam, and ceftolozane-tazobactam.

### **Beta-Oxidation**

The catabolic process by which fatty acid molecules are broken down in the mitochondria (and peroxisomes) to generate acetyl-CoA, NADH, and FADH<sub>2</sub>.

### **Beta-Thalassemia**

An inherited hemoglobin disorder with deficient or absent beta-globin chain synthesis, ranging from mild trait to transfusion-dependent major disease with iron overload, extramedullary hematopoiesis, and skeletal changes.

### **Bezoar**

A mass of indigestible material retained in the gastrointestinal tract, commonly composed of hair, plant fiber, or medication material.

### **BI-RADS**

Breast Imaging-Reporting and Data System. Standardizes mammography reporting. Categories: 0 (incomplete), 1 (negative), 2 (benign), 3 (probably benign), 4 (suspicious), 5 (highly suggestive of malignancy), 6 (known biopsy-proven malignancy).

### **Bicarbonate**

The principal extracellular buffer anion, formed from carbon dioxide and water and regulated chiefly by the lungs and kidneys. The bicarbonate-carbonic-acid system helps maintain arterial pH; serum bicarbonate is commonly used to assess metabolic components of acid-base disorders.

### **Biceps Brachii Muscle**

Two-headed anterior arm muscle. Long head from supraglenoid tubercle, short head from coracoid process, both inserting on the radial tuberosity. Innervated by musculocutaneous nerve (C5-C6). Most powerful elbow flexor in supination; supinates forearm; weakly flexes shoulder. Distal rupture causes Popeye deformity.

### **Biceps Reflex**

A tendon reflex produced by tapping the biceps tendon, causing elbow flexion through the musculocutaneous nerve and predominantly C5-C6 spinal segments. It helps assess the corresponding peripheral and central pathways.

### **Bicipital Groove**

The intertubercular groove of the humerus that transmits the tendon of the long head of the biceps brachii, with the transverse humeral ligament and adjacent rotator-cuff structures contributing to tendon stability.

### **Bicipital Tuberosity**

The radial tuberosity, a roughened prominence on the proximal radius where the biceps brachii tendon

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inserts and produces flexion and supination of the forearm.

### **Bicuspid Aortic Valve**

A congenital aortic valve with two leaflets instead of the usual three. It can lead to aortic stenosis, aortic regurgitation, enlargement of the aorta, or other congenital heart abnormalities.

### **Bicuspid Valve**

A heart valve with two leaflets rather than the usual three. The term most often refers to congenital bicuspid aortic valve, which can cause aortic stenosis, regurgitation, infective endocarditis, or ascending-aortic disease.

### **Bietti's Crystalline Dystrophy**

A rare autosomal recessive chorioretinal dystrophy characterized by tiny crystalline deposits in the retina and cornea with progressive chorioretinal atrophy, presenting with night blindness and progressive visual field loss beginning in early adulthood.

### **Biguanide**

A class of medicines that lower blood glucose by reducing hepatic glucose production and improving insulin sensitivity. Metformin is the principal biguanide in current clinical use; its use depends on kidney function, tolerability, and the person's treatment goals.

### **Bilateral Peritonsillar Abscesses**

Suppurative infection in the peritonsillar space on both sides, a rare complication of acute tonsillitis presenting with severe sore throat, dysphagia, trismus, and muffled hot potato voice. Bilateral involvement risks acute upper airway obstruction and requires urgent needle aspiration or incision and drainage.

### **Bile Acids**

Substances produced by the liver that aid digestion and absorption of fats and fat-soluble vitamins. They are also measured when a hepatobiliary disorder, including intrahepatic cholestasis of pregnancy, is suspected.

### **Bile Duct**

A channel that carries bile from the liver and gallbladder to the duodenum. The right and left hepatic ducts unite as the common hepatic duct; union with the cystic duct forms the common bile duct, which usually joins the pancreatic duct before entering the duodenum at the major duodenal papilla.

### **Bile Reflux**

Reflux of duodenal contents (bile acids, lysolecithin, pancreatic enzymes) into the stomach and esophagus, caused by incompetence of the pyloric sphincter, prior gastric surgery (Billroth II, Roux-en-Y, vagotomy with pyloroplasty), cholecystectomy, or functional gastroparesis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Reflux, Bile

### **Bile Salt Emulsification**

Bile salts (derived from cholesterol in the liver) are amphipathic molecules with hydrophobic and hydrophilic regions that act as biological detergents, emulsifying dietary lipids into smaller droplets (micelles). This increases the surface area of lipid substrate available for pancreatic lipase action.

### **Bile Salt Malabsorption**

Condition characterized by impaired reabsorption of bile acids in the terminal ileum leading to excessive bile acids entering the colon where they stimulate water and electrolyte secretion causing chronic watery diarrhea.

### **Bilharzia**

A parasitic infection caused by *Schistosoma* species. See Schistosomiasis.

### **Biliary Atresia**

A progressive, obliterative cholangiopathy of the extrahepatic bile ducts in neonates, leading to biliary obstruction, cholestasis, and ultimately biliary cirrhosis if untreated.

#### **Synonyms:**

Congenital Biliary Atresia Extrahepatic Biliary Atresia



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## **Biliary Cirrhosis**

Chronic liver scarring associated with long-standing injury to the bile ducts. The term is often used for primary biliary cholangitis, an autoimmune small-duct disease.

## **Biliary Colic**

Episodic right-upper-quadrant or epigastric pain caused by transient obstruction of the cystic duct, usually by a gallstone. Pain is typically steady, may follow meals, and resolves when the obstruction passes; fever and persistent inflammatory findings suggest a complication.

## **Biliary Dyskinesia**

A functional gallbladder disorder causing biliary-type pain without gallstones or another clear structural cause. A hepatobiliary scan may show abnormal gallbladder emptying, but no single ejection-fraction cutoff establishes the diagnosis; other causes must be considered.

## **Biliary Fever**

Fever associated with infection or inflammation of the biliary tract, classically acute ascending cholangitis. It may occur with right-upper-quadrant pain and jaundice and can progress rapidly to sepsis.

## **Biliary Stent**

A tube placed in a bile duct to maintain drainage when the duct is narrowed or blocked. Stents may be plastic or metal, and complications include migration, blockage, infection, and pancreatitis.

## **Biliary Tract**

The network of ducts that carries bile from the liver and gallbladder to the small intestine. Blockage or inflammation can cause abdominal pain, jaundice, infection, or pancreatitis.

## **Biliary Tract Injuries**

Damage to the gallbladder, bile ducts, or adjacent biliary structures, often occurring after abdominal surgery or trauma. It may cause bile leakage, obstruction, jaundice, infection, or later biliary narrowing.

## **Bilious Vomiting**

Vomiting of green/yellow, bilious material in the newborn or infant, defined as emerald green or yellow vomitus that contains bile.

## **Bilirubin**

A yellow pigment formed mainly from heme breakdown. Unconjugated bilirubin is transported bound to albumin to the liver, where it is conjugated with glucuronic acid and excreted in bile; accumulation causes jaundice.

## **Bilirubin Encephalopathy**

Neurologic injury caused by deposition of unconjugated bilirubin in the brain, especially the basal ganglia. Severe neonatal hyperbilirubinemia can produce acute lethargy, abnormal tone, feeding difficulty, seizures, and permanent kernicterus.

## **Bilirubin Metabolism**

Bilirubin is the breakdown product of heme from senescent red blood cells, metabolized primarily by the liver through a series of enzymatic steps. Heme is converted to biliverdin by heme oxygenase, then to unconjugated bilirubin by biliverdin reductase. Unconjugated bilirubin is lipophilic and transported bound to albumin to the liver.

## **Bilirubinuria**

The presence of conjugated bilirubin in urine. It indicates that water-soluble bilirubin has entered the circulation, often because of hepatocellular disease or biliary obstruction.

## **Binet-Simon Scale**

An early developmental assessment used to estimate intellectual functioning in children by comparing performance with age-based tasks. Modern evaluation uses standardized, validated developmental and cognitive instruments.

## **Binge Eating Disorder**

Recurrent episodes of eating large quantities of food with a sense of lack of control, without regular compensatory behavior. Associated with obesity, depression, and anxiety. Diagnosis by DSM-5 criteria.



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Treatment: cognitive behavioral therapy, interpersonal therapy, and SSRIs. Weight management with dietary counseling and exercise.

### **Binocular Visual Loss**

Reduction in vision affecting both eyes simultaneously, typically resulting from bilateral optic neuropathy, chiasmal lesions, or diffuse bilateral retinal disease rather than monocular ocular pathology. Evaluation requires neuroimaging and visual field testing to localise the lesion along the visual pathway.

### **Bioabsorbable Stent (Vascular)**

A vascular scaffold designed to provide temporary support and gradually break down after its function is completed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Bioavailability**

The fraction of an administered drug that reaches the systemic circulation in its unchanged active form. It is expressed as a percentage and is determined by the route of administration and the extent of first-pass metabolism. For intravenous administration, bioavailability is 100 percent by definition.

### **Bioburden**

The number and type of viable microorganisms contaminating a surface, medical device, tissue, or pharmaceutical product; a measure of contamination. Bioburden testing assesses the level of microbial contamination (total viable count) before sterilization or in quality control.

### **Biochemical Assessment**

Blood tests: albumin, prealbumin, transferrin, electrolytes, vitamins, minerals, glucose, lipids. Reflect nutritional status and metabolic function.

### **Biocompatibility**

Ability of material to function without adverse response. ISO 10993 standards for biocompatibility testing.

### **Biodegradable Implant**

An implant designed to perform a temporary function and then degrade into products that can be metabolized or eliminated by the body. Degradation rate, local tissue response, and mechanical strength must be matched to the intended clinical use.

### **Biodistribution**

The time-dependent distribution of a radiopharmaceutical among organs, tissues, blood, and excretory pathways. It determines image quality, target-to-background contrast, therapeutic delivery, and radiation exposure to normal organs.

### **Bioequivalence**

The property of two drug products (brand-name and generic) that have the same rate and extent of absorption when administered at the same molar dose under similar conditions, resulting in comparable bioavailability and therapeutic effect.

### **Bioethics**

Interdisciplinary study of the ethical, legal, philosophical, and social implications of advancements in medicine, biology, healthcare technology, and biotechnology.

### **Bioethics (Geriatric)**

Ethical considerations in elderly care: autonomy vs. paternalism, informed consent capacity, end-of-life decisions, resource allocation, elder abuse. Principles: respect for autonomy, beneficence, non-maleficence, justice. Advance directives: living will, durable power of attorney for healthcare.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Biofilm**

An organized community of microorganisms attached to a surface and embedded in a self-produced extracellular polymeric matrix (polysaccharides, proteins, DNA).

### **Biofilm-Associated Infections**

Infections caused by bacteria growing in biofilms on

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medical devices or tissues. Biofilms are structured communities of bacteria embedded in extracellular polymeric substances. Bacteria in biofilms are more resistant to antibiotics and host immune responses.

### **Biologic Therapy**

Treatment with biologic agents targeting specific immune pathways, used in autoimmune and inflammatory disease.

### **Biologic Therapy In Dermatology**

Treatment with targeted biological agents, usually monoclonal antibodies or receptor proteins, that inhibit selected immune pathways. Biologics are used for diseases such as psoriasis, atopic dermatitis, hidradenitis suppurativa, and urticaria; infection risk, vaccination status, screening, and monitoring must be considered.

### **Biologic Variation**

Natural fluctuation in a measurable analyte within an individual over time and variation between individuals. It should be considered when interpreting serial results and deciding whether a change is clinically meaningful.

### **Biological Half-Life**

Time required for the human body to eliminate half the administered quantity of a drug or radiopharmaceutical through metabolic and excretory processes. Different from physical half-life (radioactive decay) and effective half-life (combined biological and physical elimination). Formula:  $1/T_{\text{effective}} = 1/T_{\text{physical}} + 1/T_{\text{biological}}$ .

### **Biomarker**

Measurable indicator of disease. Cancer biomarkers: diagnostic, prognostic, predictive.

### **Biomarker Testing**

Laboratory analysis of biological features, such as genes, proteins, or metabolites, that may help diagnose disease, estimate prognosis, or guide treatment.

### **Biomechanics**

Study of movement mechanics. Gait analysis, joint forces, muscle activation. Applied to rehabilitation device design.

### **Biomolecule**

Any organic molecule produced by living organisms, essential for structure, function, and regulation of biological processes.

### **Biomonitoring**

Measurement of substances in body. Examples: blood glucose, drug levels, toxicants.

### **Biophysical Profile**

A non-stress test combined with ultrasound assessment of five fetal parameters, each scored 0 or 2 for a total of 0-10. Parameters include non-stress test (fetal heart rate reactivity), fetal breathing movements, fetal tone, fetal movement, and amniotic fluid volume.

### **Biopsy**

Removal of tissue for histological examination to diagnose disease. Types: needle biopsy (fine needle aspiration, core needle), excisional, incisional, punch, endoscopic. Sites: breast, lung, liver, lymph node, bone marrow. Complications: bleeding, infection, seeding (rare).

### **Biopsy Needle**

A needle designed to obtain cells or tissue for cytologic or histopathologic examination. Fine-needle aspiration retrieves cells, whereas core biopsy obtains a tissue cylinder that preserves architecture.

### **Biosensor**

A device that combines a biological recognition element with a physical or chemical transducer to detect and measure an analyte. Medical examples include sensors for glucose, pathogens, hormones, and cardiac biomarkers.

### **Biosimilar**

A biologic medicine highly similar to an approved

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reference biologic, with no clinically meaningful differences in safety, purity, or potency for its approved uses. Because biologics are complex, biosimilarity is established through a comparative evidence program rather than simple chemical identity.

### **Biot Breathing**

An irregular breathing pattern with random periods of normal breathing interspersed with apneic episodes, seen in brainstem lesions. It is less organized than Cheyne-Stokes breathing and indicates medullary damage.

### **Biotelemetry**

The remote measurement and transmission of physiologic data from a person or animal. Clinical applications include ambulatory cardiac rhythm monitoring, temperature monitoring, and intensive-care observation.

### **Bioterrorism Agents**

Category A: anthrax (*Bacillus anthracis*), smallpox (*variola*), botulism (*Clostridium botulinum*), plague (*Yersinia pestis*), tularemia (*Francisella tularensis*), viral hemorrhagic fevers (Ebola, Marburg, Lassa, Machupo). Anthrax: inhalational (mediastinal widening, hemorrhagic mediastinitis), cutaneous (eschar), GI.

### **Biotinidase Deficiency**

An autosomal recessive inborn error of biotin recycling caused by BTB gene mutations, resulting in inability to cleave biotin from biocytin (proteolytic degradation product of biotin-dependent carboxylases).

### **Biotransformation**

The process by which drugs and other xenobiotics are chemically modified by metabolic enzymes, primarily in the liver, to facilitate elimination from the body. Biotransformation occurs in two phases.

### **Biotrauma**

Inflammatory response to ventilator-induced lung injury with systemic cytokine release. Can lead to multi-organ dysfunction. Minimized by lung-

protective ventilation strategies.

### **BiPAP**

Bilevel Positive Airway Pressure, a form of non-invasive ventilation delivering two levels of pressure: IPAP (inspiratory) for ventilation and EPAP (expiratory) for alveolar recruitment. It is particularly effective for COPD exacerbations with hypercapnic respiratory failure. It reduces work of breathing and improves gas exchange.

### **BiPAP Machine**

A device that provides two levels of positive airway pressure, commonly a higher pressure during inhalation and a lower pressure during exhalation.

### **Biparietal Diameter**

The transverse diameter of the fetal skull measured at the level of the thalami and cavum septum pellucidum. Used for dating (14-26 weeks,  $\pm 7$ -10 days) and assessing growth. Normal growth: 2-4 mm per week. BPD is less reliable after 26 weeks and in abnormal fetal head shapes (dolichocephaly, brachycephaly).

### **Bipolar Disorder**

A mood disorder characterized by episodes of mania/hypomania and depression. Bipolar I: at least one manic episode (elevated mood, grandiosity, decreased need for sleep, pressured speech, increased goal-directed activity, risky behavior) lasting  $\geq 1$  week or requiring hospitalization.

#### **Synonyms:**

Manic-Depressive Illness

### **Bipolar I Disorder**

A mood disorder defined by at least one manic episode lasting at least seven days or requiring hospitalization. A manic episode is a distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood and increased goal-directed activity or energy.

### **Bipolar II Disorder**

A mood disorder characterized by at least one hypomanic episode and at least one major depressive episode, with no history of a full manic episode.

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The depressive episodes in bipolar II tend to be more frequent and longer-lasting than in bipolar I, leading to greater cumulative disability.

### **Bird Fancier's Lung**

HP from avian proteins in bird droppings or feathers. Common among pigeon breeders. Chronic exposure leads to progressive fibrosis.

### **Bird Flu**

Influenza caused by avian-adapted influenza A viruses. Human infection is uncommon but may cause severe respiratory disease, and public-health assessment depends on exposure history, testing, and infection-control measures.

### **Birt-Hogg-Dube Syndrome**

Autosomal dominant disorder caused by mutations in the FLCN gene (17p11.2) encoding folliculin.

### **Birth Control**

Methods used to prevent pregnancy, including barrier, hormonal, intrauterine, behavioral, and permanent methods.

### **Birthmarks**

Congenital or early-appearing marks on the skin, including vascular lesions such as hemangiomas and port-wine stains and pigmented lesions such as nevi and café-au-lait macules. Most are benign, but changes in appearance warrant assessment.

### **Bishop Score**

A clinical score used before labor induction to describe cervical readiness. It incorporates cervical dilation, effacement, consistency, position, and fetal-head station; a more favorable cervix generally indicates a greater likelihood of successful induction.

### **Bisphenol A**

Endocrine disruptor in plastics. Estrogenic effects, associated with reproductive disorders, obesity, diabetes. Avoid BPA-containing products, especially for children.

### **Bitemporal Hemianopia**

Loss of vision in the temporal (lateral) half of both visual fields due to lesions that cross the optic chiasm, damaging the decussating fibers from the nasal retina of each eye (which carry temporal field information).

### **Bitewing**

A dental radiograph that records the crowns of the upper and lower teeth and the adjacent alveolar bone in one image. It is particularly useful for detecting interproximal caries and assessing crestal bone levels.

### **Bitewing Radiograph**

An intraoral radiograph showing the crowns of the maxillary and mandibular posterior teeth and the alveolar crest. It is particularly useful for detecting interproximal caries and assessing crestal bone levels.

### **Bitot's Spots**

Foamy, whitish, triangular patches on the conjunctiva, usually near the temporal limbus, associated classically with vitamin A deficiency. They may accompany night blindness and xerosis of the conjunctiva or cornea.

### **BK Virus Nephropathy**

Polyomavirus infection in transplant recipients. Viral cytopathic changes on biopsy. Reduce immunosuppression as primary treatment. Can lead to graft loss. Monitor viral loads in blood for early detection.

### **Black Eye**

Bruising and swelling around the eye, usually caused by blunt trauma. Vision may remain normal, but eye pain, double vision, reduced vision, an irregular pupil, severe headache, vomiting, or loss of consciousness can indicate an eye or orbital injury and requires urgent assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Eye Black (Black Eye)

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## Black Hairy Tongue

A benign elongation and dark discoloration of the filiform papillae on the dorsal tongue caused by impaired desquamation and trapping of debris or pigment. Predisposing factors include smoking, poor oral hygiene, dry mouth, and some exposures.

## Black Lung

Coal workers' pneumoconiosis caused by prolonged inhalation of coal-mine dust. It ranges from simple anthracosis to progressive massive fibrosis and may cause cough, breathlessness, and permanent lung impairment.

## Black Stain

Dark discoloration on the tooth surface, often near the gumline, caused by external deposits or chromogenic bacteria. Dental assessment determines the cause and appropriate removal.

## Black Triangle

Triangular space between teeth at gumline. Caused by papilla loss, tooth shape, bone level. Treatment: orthodontics, restorative, papilla reconstruction.

## Blackheads

Open comedones formed when a hair follicle becomes blocked with sebum and keratin and the surface material oxidizes. They are a common non-inflammatory lesion of acne, especially on the face, chest, and back.

## Bladder Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the urinary bladder, most often from the urothelial lining. Blood in the urine is a common presenting feature, although symptoms vary.

### Synonyms:

Bladder Carcinoma (Bladder Cancer)

## Bladder Carcinoma

A malignant tumor arising in the urinary bladder, most often from the urothelial lining. Blood in the urine is a common presenting sign; smoking and certain occupational chemical exposures increase

risk.

## Bladder Diverticula

Outpouchings of the bladder mucosa through the muscular wall, often acquired from chronic bladder outlet obstruction or congenital in origin. Acquired diverticula are associated with benign prostatic hyperplasia and may cause urinary stasis, recurrent infections, and stone formation.

## Bladder Diverticulum

Outpouching of bladder wall. Congenital or acquired (obstruction). Asymptomatic or causes urinary stasis, stones, infection. Treatment: address obstruction, diverticulectomy if symptomatic.

## Bladder Exstrophy

A rare congenital abdominal wall defect where the bladder is exposed on the outside of the body due to failure of the lower abdominal wall and bladder to close during embryonic development. Part of the exstrophy-epispadias complex. Associated with pubic bone diastasis, external genital anomalies, and potential bladder dysfunction.

## Bladder Fistula

An abnormal connection between the bladder and another organ or the skin, most often the vagina, bowel, or uterus. It may cause continuous urine leakage, recurrent infections, gas or stool in the urine, or unusual vaginal wetness. Treatment depends on the cause and may require catheter drainage and surgical repair.

## Bladder Health And Disorders

Bladder health involves the proper storage and voluntary release of urine through coordinated function of the detrusor muscle and sphincters. Common disorders include urinary tract infections, overactive bladder, stress incontinence, and interstitial cystitis.

## Bladder Outlet Obstruction

Blockage of urine flow at the bladder neck or urethra, commonly caused by benign prostatic enlargement, urethral stricture, stones, tumors, or pelvic-organ prolapse. It may cause weak stream, hesitancy,

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retention, hydronephrosis, infection, and renal impairment.

### **Bladder Pain Syndrome**

Chronic bladder-related pain, pressure, or discomfort associated with urinary symptoms in the absence of infection or another identifiable cause. It is a diagnosis of exclusion and is managed with multimodal, patient-centered treatment.

### **Bladder Perforation**

A tear or hole in the bladder wall caused by trauma, pelvic surgery, instrumentation, severe inflammation, or obstruction. Urine may leak into surrounding tissues, causing abdominal pain, distention, blood in the urine, or infection. It requires urgent medical assessment and may need catheter drainage or surgical repair.

### **Bladder Problems**

A range of conditions affecting urine storage and voiding, including incontinence, overactive bladder, urinary retention, and recurrent infections. Causes may include neurological damage, pelvic floor weakness, prostate enlargement, or bladder outlet obstruction.

### **Bladder Retraining**

Scheduled voiding and gradual increases in the time between voids to improve bladder control.

### **Bladder Spasm**

An involuntary contraction of the bladder muscle that can cause sudden urgency, cramping, urine leakage, or pain. It may occur with infection, catheter use, bladder irritation, neurological conditions, or after surgery. Treatment addresses the cause and may include bladder training or medicines.

### **Bladder Stone**

A mineral deposit formed in or entering the urinary bladder. It may cause painful urination, blood in the urine, interrupted flow, or recurrent infection; treatment addresses the stone and its cause.

### **Blalock-Taussig Operation**

A surgical systemic-to-pulmonary shunt that increases pulmonary blood flow in selected cyanotic congenital heart disease. The modern modified procedure commonly uses a prosthetic conduit rather than direct sacrifice of a subclavian artery.

### **Blast Crisis**

Aggressive, terminal phase of myeloid (chiefly CML) or, less commonly, lymphoid malignancies in which immature blasts dominate the marrow and peripheral blood, behaving like acute leukemia. CML blast crisis is defined by 20% blasts in peripheral blood or bone marrow or by the presence of extramedullary blastic infiltrates (chloromas).

### **Blast Injury**

Tissue injury caused by an explosion, classified as primary injury from the pressure wave, secondary injury from projectiles, tertiary injury from displacement or impact, and quaternary injury from burns, inhalation, toxins, or crush. Multiple mechanisms may coexist.

### **Blastic Plasmacytoid Dendritic-Cell Neoplasm**

A rare, aggressive hematologic malignancy derived from plasmacytoid dendritic cells. It often involves skin, bone marrow, lymph nodes, and central nervous system, with a poor prognosis.

### **Blastocyst**

An early stage in embryonic development, consisting of a hollow sphere of cells that implants into the uterine wall.

### **Blastoma**

Generic descriptor for embryonal (primitive) malignant tumors arising from precursor ("blast") cells that fail to differentiate normally.

### **Blastomyces Dermatitidis**

A dimorphic fungus that causes blastomycosis, a systemic pyogranulomatous infection acquired by inhalation of conidia from soil in endemic regions such as the Ohio and Mississippi River valleys. Cuta-



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neous manifestations include verrucous or ulcerated plaques, and pulmonary involvement is common.

### **Blastomycosis**

A fungal infection caused by *Blastomyces dermatitidis*, endemic to the Ohio and Mississippi River valleys and Great Lakes region. Inhalation of conidia causes pulmonary infection. Pulmonary: acute pneumonia (often misdiagnosed as bacterial), chronic pneumonia with nodules and cavitation.

### **Bleeding**

The escape of blood from the vascular system, which may be external (visible hemorrhage from a wound, orifice, or natural opening) or internal (bleeding into a body cavity, organ, or tissue).

### **Bleeding Disorders**

A heterogeneous group of conditions characterized by abnormal hemostasis, resulting from defects in blood vessels, platelets, or coagulation factors.

### **Bleeding Esophageal Varices**

Life-threatening hemorrhage from dilated submucosal veins in the lower esophagus, occurring as a complication of portal hypertension, most commonly from cirrhosis. Varices form when the portal venous pressure gradient exceeds 10 mmHg (the threshold for variceal development).

### **Bleeding Gums**

Bleeding from the gum tissue, often caused by plaque-related gingivitis, periodontitis, trauma, or vigorous brushing. It can also occur with blood disorders or medicines that affect clotting. Persistent bleeding, swelling, loose teeth, or spontaneous bleeding requires dental or medical evaluation.

### **Bleeding Into A Thyroid Nodule**

Hemorrhage within a thyroid nodule, presenting with sudden onset of neck pain and rapid enlargement of a pre-existing or new thyroid mass. It may mimic thyroid malignancy clinically and on imaging. Ultrasound shows a complex cystic lesion with internal echoes. Fine needle aspiration confirms the benign nature of the hemorrhagic cyst.

### **Blennorrhea**

A mucopurulent discharge from a mucous membrane, especially the urethra or conjunctiva. The finding requires clinical assessment for infectious and noninfectious causes rather than treatment based on the symptom alone.

### **Blepharitis**

Chronic inflammation of the eyelid margins, one of the most common ophthalmic conditions, classified into anterior blepharitis (affecting the eyelash follicle and base) and posterior blepharitis (affecting the meibomian glands).

#### **Synonyms:**

Eyelid Inflammation Eyelid Inflammation (Blepharitis)

### **Blepharoconjunctivitis**

Inflammation involving the eyelid margins and conjunctiva. It may cause crusting, itching, redness, tearing, irritation, and recurrent symptoms associated with infection, allergy, or eyelid-gland dysfunction.

### **Blepharoplasty**

Surgical reconstruction or reshaping of the eyelids, often involving removal or repositioning of excess skin, muscle, or orbital fat. It may be functional, cosmetic, or reconstructive.

### **Band Cell**

An immature neutrophil with a curved, unsegmented nucleus. An increased number in blood may occur during acute infection or inflammation.

### **Blepharospasm**

Involuntary spasms of the muscles around the eyes that cause repeated or sustained eyelid closure. It may be primary or associated with eye irritation, medications, or a neurologic disorder.

### **Blind Loop Syndrome**

Malabsorption syndrome due to stasis and bacterial overgrowth (SIBO) in a non-propulsive ("blind") segment of small bowel, classically caused by surgical

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bypass loops (Billroth II, end-to-side anastomosis), strictures (Crohn disease, radiation, adhesions), diverticulosis, or impaired motility (diabetes, scleroderma).

### **Blinding**

Concealing group assignment. Single-blind: participants. Double-blind: participants and investigators. Triple-blind: participants, investigators, analysts.

### **Blindness**

Severe or complete loss of vision in one or both eyes, caused by disease or injury affecting the cornea, lens, retina, optic nerve, visual pathways, or visual cortex. It may be congenital or acquired, sudden or progressive, and reversible or permanent; sudden visual loss is an ophthalmic emergency.

### **Blood Alcohol Concentration**

The concentration of ethanol in blood, commonly expressed as mass per volume or as a percentage. Interpretation depends on sampling, timing, metabolism, tolerance, co-ingestants, and local standards; clinical impairment cannot be inferred from a single value without context.

### **Blood Alcohol Level**

Measurement of ethanol concentration in blood. The clinical effects depend on the concentration, timing, tolerance, co-ingestants, and individual factors; a single level does not by itself determine impairment or prognosis.

### **Blood Clot**

A mass of coagulated blood within a blood vessel or body cavity. A clot may be protective when it stops bleeding, but an abnormal thrombus can obstruct blood flow or embolize to the lungs, brain, heart, or other organs.

### **Blood Coagulation**

The cascade of enzymatic reactions converting circulating fibrinogen into an insoluble fibrin clot.

### **Blood Coagulation Disorder**

A disorder in which clot formation is deficient, excessive, or inappropriately regulated, causing abnormal bleeding or thrombosis. Causes include inherited factor deficiencies, platelet disorders, liver disease, vitamin deficiencies, immune conditions, and acquired systemic disease.

### **Blood Culture**

A laboratory test in which blood is placed in culture bottles to detect bacteria or fungi in the bloodstream. It is used when bloodstream infection, sepsis, or infective endocarditis is suspected.

### **Blood Culture Contamination**

Introduction of skin or environmental microorganisms into a blood-culture bottle during collection or handling rather than true bloodstream infection. It can lead to unnecessary antimicrobial treatment and should be assessed using the organism, number of positive sets, time to positivity, and clinical findings.

### **Blood Film (Peripheral Blood Smear)**

A stained microscopic preparation of peripheral blood used to assess erythrocyte, leukocyte, and platelet morphology and to detect abnormal cells, parasites, blasts, and red-cell fragments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peripheral Blood Smear

### **Blood Flow**

The volume of blood passing through a vessel, organ, or the systemic circulation per unit time, typically expressed in mL/min. Governed by the hemodynamic equivalent of Ohm's law: flow = pressure gradient / resistance. Total cardiac output (5 L/min at rest) equals systemic blood flow.

### **Blood Gas (Venous)**

Sampling of venous blood (typically from a peripheral vein or central line) for pH, PvCO<sub>2</sub>, HCO<sub>3</sub>, and base excess. Less painful than ABG, avoids arterial puncture risks. Limitations: no PaO<sub>2</sub> or SpO<sub>2</sub> data; peripheral venous gases in shock may not reflect arterial pH. VBG pH is typically 0.03-0.05 lower than

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ABG; PvCO<sub>2</sub> is 3-8 mmHg higher.

**Synonyms:**

Venous

### **Blood Glucose Monitoring**

Blood sugar monitoring involves measuring glucose levels in the blood to manage diabetes, typically using a glucometer with finger-stick testing or continuous glucose monitors that track interstitial glucose in real time.

### **Blood Group**

The classification of blood based on the presence or absence of specific antigens (agglutinogens) on the surface of red blood cells. The ABO system has four groups: A (A antigen), B (B antigen), AB (both A and B), and O (neither A nor B). The Rh system: RhD-positive (85% of population) or RhD-negative (15%).

### **Blood In Semen**

Hematospermia, or the presence of blood in the ejaculate. It is often temporary and related to inflammation, infection, recent urologic procedures, or trauma, but persistent or recurrent bleeding, pain, fever, urinary symptoms, or bleeding in older men warrants medical evaluation.

**Synonyms:**

Semen Blood (Blood In Semen)

### **Hematospermia**

Blood in the semen, often temporary and associated with infection, inflammation, trauma, or a recent urologic procedure. Persistent or recurrent bleeding, pain, fever, urinary symptoms, or bleeding in an older adult requires medical evaluation.

### **Blood Loss**

The volume of blood lost during surgery or trauma, estimated by weighing swabs, suction contents, and hemodynamic monitoring, guiding fluid and transfusion management.

### **Blood Pressure**

The force exerted by blood against arterial walls,

measured in millimeters of mercury (mmHg). Systolic pressure (peak during ventricular ejection, normally approximately 120 mmHg) and diastolic pressure (minimum during ventricular relaxation, normally approximately 80 mmHg).

### **Blood Products**

Components prepared from donated blood for transfusion, including red blood cells, platelets, plasma, and cryoprecipitate. Each component has specific indications, benefits, and risks; selection depends on the patient's clinical condition and laboratory findings.

### **Blood Smear**

Peripheral blood film: a thin blood smear on a slide stained (Wright/Giemsa) and examined microscopically for cell morphology, aiding diagnosis.

### **Blood Spatter Analysis**

The forensic interpretation of bloodstain patterns to reconstruct events surrounding a violent incident. Types: passive (drops, pools, flows), transfer (contact patterns), and impact/expired spatter.

### **Blood Sugar Test**

Measurement of blood glucose to detect or monitor diabetes and other disorders of glucose regulation. Testing may be performed fasting, randomly, or after a glucose load, using a laboratory sample or a point-of-care meter.

### **Blood Transfusion**

The administration of whole blood or blood components (packed red blood cells, platelets, fresh frozen plasma, cryoprecipitate) to restore or maintain adequate circulating blood volume and oxygen-carrying capacity.

### **Blood Urea Nitrogen**

BUN: serum urea, the end product of protein catabolism, filtered and partially reabsorbed by the tubules. Used with creatinine to assess renal function and volume status.

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### **Blood Viscosity**

The internal friction of blood that resists flow, determined primarily by hematocrit (red cell concentration), with smaller contributions from plasma proteins and temperature. Normal whole-blood viscosity is approximately 3-4 times that of water.

### **Blood-Borne Disease**

An infection that can spread through contact with infected blood or other body fluids. Examples include HIV and hepatitis B and C.

### **Blood-Brain Barrier**

The blood-brain barrier is a highly selective semipermeable membrane that separates the circulating blood from the brain extracellular fluid, consisting of endothelial cells connected by tight junctions, astrocyte foot processes, and a basement membrane.

### **Bloom Syndrome**

Rare autosomal recessive chromosomal instability syndrome caused by biallelic mutations in BLM (15q26.1) encoding a RecQ helicase.

### **Blount Disease**

A growth disorder of the proximal tibia causing progressive bowing of the legs, usually involving the medial tibial physis. It may occur in infants or adolescents and can lead to gait abnormality, limb-length discrepancy, and early knee degeneration.

### **Blue Baby**

Generic term for an infant with cyanosis (bluish skin, lips, nail beds) from arterial oxygen desaturation.

### **Blue Bloater**

A clinical phenotype of chronic bronchitis in COPD. Patients present with chronic cough, sputum production, cyanosis, right heart failure, and airway-centric inflammation. They tend to be younger, have more hypercapnia, and less emphysema on imaging.

### **Blunt Abdominal Trauma**

Trauma to the abdomen without penetrating injury. Mechanisms: motor vehicle collisions (most

common), falls, assaults. Commonly injured organs: spleen (most common, left upper quadrant), liver (right upper quadrant), kidneys (flank), bowel (seatbelt sign, delayed perforation), and pancreas (epigastric).

### **Blunt Force Trauma**

Injury produced when a blunt object strikes the body, or the body strikes a blunt surface, without a sharp edge penetrating the skin. Patterns include abrasions, contusions, lacerations with tissue bridging, and fractures; patterned injuries may reproduce the impacting object.

### **BMI (Body Mass Index)**

Weight in kg divided by height in meters squared. Screening tool for weight categories: underweight ( $<18.5$ ), normal ( $18.5-24.9$ ), overweight ( $25-29.9$ ), obese ( $\geq 30$ ). Limitations: does not distinguish muscle from fat, may misclassify athletes, elderly, certain ethnic groups.

#### **Synonyms:**

Body Mass Index

### **BNP**

B-type natriuretic peptide. Marker of heart failure. Released from ventricles in response to stretch.

### **Bocavirus Infection**

Infection caused by human bocavirus, a respiratory virus that most often affects young children. It may cause cough, wheezing, fever, runny nose, bronchiolitis, or pneumonia and can occur with other respiratory infections. Treatment is generally supportive; breathing difficulty, dehydration, or marked lethargy requires prompt assessment.

### **Bochdalek Hernia**

A congenital diaphragmatic hernia (CDH) occurring through the posterolateral foramen of Bochdalek, resulting from failure of the pleuroperitoneal membrane to close by the 8th week of gestation. The left side is affected in 85% of cases (the right pleuroperitoneal canal closes earlier).

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## Body Aches

Generalized muscle or body pain that may occur with viral infections, fever, exertion, inflammation, medication effects, or other systemic illness. Severe pain with weakness, dark urine, breathing difficulty, chest pain, or high fever requires prompt medical assessment.

## Body Dysmorphic Disorder

Preoccupation with one or more perceived defects or flaws in physical appearance that are not observable or appear slight to others. The individual performs repetitive behaviors in response to appearance concerns such as mirror checking, excessive grooming, skin picking, reassurance seeking, and comparing.

### Synonyms:

BDD

## Body Identification

The process of establishing the identity of a deceased person, essential in forensic and mass-disaster contexts.

## Body Lice

Infestation of clothing and skin by the human body louse, causing intense itching, excoriations, and sometimes secondary bacterial infection. Treatment requires hygiene, laundering or heat treatment of clothing and bedding, and appropriate antiparasitic measures.

### Synonyms:

Lice, Body

## Body Plethysmography

Technique for measuring lung volumes (TLC, RV, FRC) using a sealed chamber. Gold standard for TLC measurement. Useful for diagnosing restriction and hyperinflation.

## Body Ringworm

Dermatophyte infection of the glabrous skin, also called tinea corporis. It typically produces an expanding annular scaly lesion with a more active border and central clearing.

### Synonyms:

tinea corporis.

## Body Temperature

The balance between heat production (metabolism, muscle activity) and heat loss (radiation, conduction, convection, evaporation). See Temperature (Body Temperature).

## Boeck's Sarcoid

An older eponym for sarcoidosis, a multisystem granulomatous disease characterized by noncaseating granulomas and commonly involving the lungs, intrathoracic lymph nodes, skin, or eyes.

## Boerhaave Syndrome

Transmural spontaneous rupture of the esophagus typically occurring after forceful vomiting in the setting of a full stomach. Most commonly involves the left posterolateral wall of the distal esophagus. Presents with severe chest pain, subcutaneous emphysema, mediastinal emphysema, and rapidly progressive sepsis.

## Bohn Nodules

Small, benign keratin-filled cysts on the gums or palate of a newborn that usually resolve without treatment.

## Bohr Effect

The decrease in hemoglobin's oxygen affinity (right shift of the dissociation curve) caused by decreased pH (increased H<sup>+</sup>) and increased PCO<sub>2</sub>. In metabolically active tissues, CO<sub>2</sub> production and lactic acid accumulation lower the local pH, causing hemoglobin to release more oxygen precisely where it is needed most.

## Boil

Furuncle: an acute, deep infection of a hair follicle (folliculitis that extends to the dermis) by *Staphylococcus aureus*, forming a painful, red, swollen nodule with central purulent core that may spontaneously drain.

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## **Boil (Furuncle)**

A painful, deep-seated infection of a hair follicle caused most commonly by *Staphylococcus aureus*, extending into the surrounding subcutaneous tissue. Presents as a tender, erythematous, fluctuant nodule that eventually discharges pus. When multiple adjacent follicles coalesce, it forms a carbuncle, often with systemic symptoms.

### **Synonyms:**

Furuncle

## **Bone**

A rigid, mineralised connective tissue that forms the skeleton, providing structural support, protection of vital organs, hematopoiesis (bone marrow), and mineral storage (calcium, phosphate). Bone composition: organic matrix (90% type I collagen) and inorganic mineral (hydroxyapatite, calcium phosphate).

## **Bone Cancer**

Cancer that begins in bone, such as osteosarcoma or chondrosarcoma, or cancer that has spread to bone from another organ. Possible features include persistent localized bone pain, swelling, or a fracture after minor trauma. Diagnosis requires imaging and tissue evaluation; treatment depends on the type and extent of disease.

### **Synonyms:**

Sarcoma, Bone Cancer

## **Bone Cement (Polymethylmethacrylate—PMMA)**

Acrylic polymer used to fix prosthetic joints to bone. Mixes as dough, cures exothermically. Used in hip/knee arthroplasty, vertebroplasty, cranial reconstruction. Complications: cement implantation syndrome (hypotension, hypoxia), infection, loosening.

### **Synonyms:**

Polymethylmethacrylate—PMMA

## **Bone Densitometry**

Dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry measures bone mineral density at the lumbar spine and hip. Results are expressed as T-score comparing to young

adult mean and Z-score comparing to age-matched controls. T-score of minus 1.0 to minus 2.5 indicates osteopenia. T-score of minus 2.5 or less indicates osteoporosis.

## **Bone Density**

The amount of mineral in bone, commonly estimated by dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry. Lower density is associated with increased fracture risk, and interpretation depends on the person's age, sex, and clinical context.

## **Bone Density Screening**

Testing, usually with DXA, that measures bone mineral density and helps estimate fracture risk or assess osteoporosis.

## **Bone Fracture**

A partial or complete break in a bone caused by injury, repeated stress, or weakened bone. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, and inability to use the limb may occur. Open fractures, loss of circulation or sensation, or major deformity require emergency care.

## **Bone Graft**

Bone tissue or a bone-substitute material used to fill a defect, promote fusion, support reconstruction, or enhance fracture healing. Autograft provides osteogenic cells and biologic signals; allograft and synthetic substitutes provide variable osteoconductive and osteoinductive properties.

## **Bone Graft (Dental)**

Material placed to augment alveolar bone. Types: autograft, allograft, xenograft, alloplast. Used for implants, ridge preservation.

### **Synonyms:**

Dental

## **Bone Health**

The strength and condition of the skeleton, influenced by bone density, structure, nutrition, hormones, activity, medicines, and disease.



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## **Bone Infection**

Infection of bone, usually caused by bacteria and called osteomyelitis. It may arise from bloodstream spread, nearby tissue, surgery, or an open injury.

## **Bone Marrow**

Vascular tissue within the medullary cavities and cancellous bone. Red marrow produces blood cells, whereas yellow marrow primarily stores fat and can revert to red marrow when demand increases.

## **Bone Marrow Aspiration**

A procedure that withdraws liquid marrow, usually from the posterior iliac crest, for cytologic, flow-cytometric, cytogenetic, molecular, and microbiologic evaluation. It complements the core biopsy, which assesses marrow architecture.

## **Bone Marrow Aspiration And Biopsy**

Sampling of bone marrow, typically from the posterior iliac crest. Aspiration: liquid marrow for cytology (differential, morphology), flow cytometry, cytogenetics, and MRD. Biopsy: core of bone for cellularity, architecture, fibrosis, and infiltrative disease (lymphoma, metastatic cancer, granulomas).

## **Bone Marrow Biopsy**

A procedure sampling bone marrow (typically posterior iliac crest) via aspiration (cytology, flow cytometry, cultures) and trephine core biopsy (histology, architecture, fibrosis, cellularity).

## **Bone Marrow Depression**

Reduced production of blood cells by the bone marrow, causing anemia, low white-cell counts, low platelet counts, or combinations of these findings.

## **Bone Marrow Hyperplasia**

Increased cellularity of the bone marrow resulting from accelerated hematopoiesis, typically compensating for chronic hemolytic anemia, hemorrhage, or systemic hypoxia.

## **Bone Marrow Necrosis**

Death of hematopoietic and stromal cells within the

bone marrow, often associated with sickle cell crisis, malignancy, or infections, presenting with severe bone pain and cytopenias.

## **Bone Metastases**

Cancer deposits that have spread to bone from another primary site. They may cause pain, fracture, high blood calcium, or spinal-cord compression.

## **Bone Metastasis**

A deposit of cancer that has spread to bone from another primary site. It may cause pain, fracture, high blood calcium, or spinal-cord compression, and treatment depends on the cancer and clinical context.

## **Bone Scan**

Skeletal imaging using Tc-99m MDP. Detects osteoblastic activity. Sensitivity: high; specificity: low. Used for metastasis detection, fracture, infection, metabolic bone disease. "Hot spots" indicate increased uptake; "cold spots" indicate decreased uptake.

## **Bone Scan (Nuclear Scintigraphy)**

Nuclear medicine imaging using Tc-99m MDP (methylene diphosphonate) that accumulates in areas of increased bone turnover. Three phases: perfusion (immediate), blood pool (5 min), and delayed (2-3 hours).

### **Synonyms:**

Nuclear Scintigraphy

## **Bone Turnover Markers**

Biochemical markers reflecting the rate of bone remodeling. Formation markers include bone-specific alkaline phosphatase, osteocalcin, and N-terminal and C-terminal propeptides of type I procollagen. Resorption markers include C-terminal and N-terminal telopeptides of type I collagen and deoxypyridinoline.

## **Bones And Joints**

Bones and joints form the skeletal system, providing structural support, protection of organs, and enabling movement through articulations between

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bones. Joints are classified as fibrous, cartilaginous, or synovial, with synovial joints offering the greatest range of motion.

### **Bony Exostosis**

A benign localized bony protuberance, including torus palatinus of the palate and torus mandibularis of the mandible. Treatment is usually unnecessary unless the lesion causes trauma, interferes with speech or prosthesis, or requires diagnostic clarification.

### **Borderline Personality Disorder**

A pattern of instability in interpersonal relationships, self-image, and affects, with marked impulsivity.

#### **Synonyms:**

BPD (Borderline Personality Disorder) Emotional Dysregulation Disorder (Borderline Personality Disorder) Personality Disorder, Borderline

### **Bordetella Pertussis**

A Gram-negative coccobacillus and the causative agent of whooping cough, a highly contagious respiratory infection. It produces pertussis toxin, which inhibits G-protein signaling in respiratory epithelial cells, and tracheal cytotoxin, which damages ciliated epithelium.

### **Bornholm Disease**

An acute epidemic pleurodynia caused most often by coxsackieviruses. It produces sudden attacks of severe chest or upper-abdominal muscle pain, fever, and sometimes headache or vomiting.

### **Borrelia**

A genus of spiral-shaped bacteria (spirochetes) transmitted by arthropod vectors, most notably ticks and lice. The major human pathogen is *Borrelia burgdorferi* sensu lato, the causative agent of Lyme disease, transmitted by Ixodes ticks.

### **Borrelia Burgdorferi**

A spirochete bacterium transmitted by Ixodes ticks and the principal cause of Lyme disease in North America and Europe.

### **Borreliosis**

Infection caused by bacteria of the genus *Borrelia*. Human disease includes Lyme borreliosis and relapsing fever, with manifestations varying according to species, stage, and organ involvement.

### **Bosniak Classification**

System classifying renal cysts by CT features. Categories I-II benign, IIF follow-up, III-IV likely malignant.

### **Bot Fly**

A parasitic fly of the family Oestridae whose larvae cause myiasis in humans and animals. *Dermatobia hominis*, the human bot fly, deposits eggs on blood-sucking insects; larvae penetrate the skin and develop subcutaneously, causing a painful boil-like lesion with a central breathing pore. Treatment is manual extraction of the larva.

### **Botryomycosis**

A chronic bacterial infection characterized by granule-forming lesions that can resemble a fungal infection. It most often affects skin and subcutaneous tissue but may involve viscera in susceptible patients.

### **Botulism**

A rare, potentially fatal neuroparalytic disease caused by botulinum toxin, a potent presynaptic neurotoxin produced by *Clostridium botulinum*, an anaerobic, spore-forming, gram-positive bacillus.

### **Bouchard's Node**

A hard, palpable enlargement of the proximal interphalangeal joint caused by osteoarthritis. It reflects osteophyte formation and may be associated with pain, stiffness, and reduced finger motion.

### **Bougienage**

The use of a bougie to dilate or explore a narrowed tubular structure, such as the esophagus or urethra. It is a procedure that requires assessment of the cause and risks of the stricture.

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### **Bourbon Virus**

A rare tick-borne viral infection associated with fever, fatigue, anorexia, nausea, and a low white-cell or platelet count. There is no established specific antiviral treatment or vaccine; management is supportive and requires exclusion of other serious tick-borne infections.

### **Boutonneuse Fever**

A tick-borne rickettsial infection, usually caused by *Rickettsia conorii*, characterized by fever, headache, rash, and often a dark inoculation eschar called a tache noire.

### **Bouveret Syndrome**

Rare variant of gallstone ileus where a large gallstone erodes through a cholecystoduodenal fistula and impacts in the duodenum or pylorus causing gastric outlet obstruction. Represents approximately two to three percent of gallstone ileus cases. Presents with nausea, vomiting, epigastric pain, and anorexia.

### **Bovine Spongiform Encephalopathy**

A fatal transmissible prion disease of cattle causing progressive neurologic degeneration. It is related to variant Creutzfeldt–Jakob disease in humans through exposure to contaminated tissue.

### **Bowel Incontinence**

The involuntary loss of solid or liquid stool through the anus, also known as fecal incontinence, affecting approximately 2-15 percent of the general population and increasing in prevalence with age.

#### **Synonyms:**

fecal.

### **Bowel Infarction**

Ischemic necrosis of bowel tissue from occlusive or non-occlusive mesenteric ischemia, presenting with severe abdominal pain out of proportion to examination, bloody stools, and peritoneal signs. Causes include mesenteric arterial embolism or thrombosis, venous thrombosis, and low-flow states.

### **Bowel Ischemia**

Reduced blood flow to the intestines causing mucosal injury, most commonly from mesenteric atherosclerosis, low-flow states, or mesenteric venous thrombosis. Presents with abdominal pain, bloody stools, and elevated lactate. Severe cases progress to transmural necrosis.

### **Bowel Obstruction**

Blockage of intestinal lumen. X-ray, CT diagnosis. Differentiate small vs. large bowel obstruction. Mechanical vs.

### **Bowel Program**

A planned routine using diet, fluids, medicines, and scheduled toileting to promote regular bowel movements and manage constipation or bowel dysfunction.

### **Bowenoid Papulosis**

A low-grade squamous intraepithelial neoplasia of the anogenital skin caused by human papillomavirus infection, typically types 16 and 18, presenting as multiple pigmented papules on the genital mucosa. Histologically it resembles squamous cell carcinoma in situ but follows a benign clinical course.

### **Bowlegs**

Outward bowing of the legs causing the knees to remain apart when the feet and ankles are together, also called genu varum. It is common in early childhood but requires assessment when severe, asymmetric, painful, or persistent beyond the expected age.

#### **Synonyms:**

genu varum.

### **Bowman Capsule**

Double-walled epithelial cup surrounding the glomerular capillaries forming the beginning of the nephron. The visceral layer is composed of podocytes whose foot processes interdigitate to form filtration slits. The parietal layer is composed of simple squamous epithelium.

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## Bowman's Gland

A serous gland in the olfactory mucosa whose secretion helps dissolve odorant molecules and cleanse the olfactory surface. It is located in the lamina propria beneath the olfactory epithelium.

## Boxed Warning

The most prominent safety warning required in prescribing information for a medicine when there is a serious or life-threatening risk. It communicates major hazards and does not necessarily mean that the medication is never appropriate.

## BPH

Abbreviation for benign prostatic hyperplasia, a noncancerous enlargement of the prostate that may obstruct urine flow.

## Brachial Artery

The continuation of the axillary artery, running from the lower border of teres major to the cubital fossa, where it divides into radial and ulnar arteries. Lies medial to the biceps; palpated for blood pressure and brachial pulse. Branches: profunda brachii (deep brachial), superior/inferior ulnar collaterals.

## Brachial Plexopathy

Dysfunction of the brachial plexus causing pain, weakness, sensory loss, or paralysis in the shoulder and upper limb. Causes include trauma, compression, tumors, inflammation, and radiation injury.

## Brachial Plexus

Nerve network (C5-T1) formed by roots, trunks, divisions, and cords, giving rise to upper limb nerves. Roots unite into superior/middle/inferior trunks, dividing into anterior/posterior divisions, recombining into lateral/posterior/medial cords. Major branches: musculocutaneous, axillary, radial, median, ulnar.

## Brachial Plexus Cords

Formed by divisions recombining behind the pectoralis minor. Lateral cord (anterior divisions of upper/middle trunks), posterior cord (all three posterior divisions), medial cord (anterior division of lower trunk). Named for relationship to the axil-

lary artery. Lateral cord: lateral pectoral nerve, contributes to median nerve.

## Brachial Plexus Injuries

Injuries to the network of nerves supplying the shoulder and upper limb, caused by traction, compression, or penetrating trauma. They may produce pain, weakness, sensory loss, or paralysis; the pattern and severity depend on which roots, trunks, or cords are affected.

## Brachial Plexus Injury

Damage to the brachial plexus nerves during birth, most commonly from shoulder dystocia or excessive traction. Erb's palsy (C5-C6) presents with waiter's tip position (arm adducted, elbow extended, forearm pronated). Klumpke's palsy (C8-T1) affects the hand and may cause Horner syndrome. Most cases resolve spontaneously.

## Brachial Plexus Roots

Ventral rami of C5-T1 emerging from intervertebral foramina, passing between anterior and middle scalene muscles (interscalene triangle). C5-C6 form the upper trunk, C7 continues as middle trunk, C8-T1 form the lower trunk. Root injuries cause specific dermatome/myotome deficits. C5 avulsion causes loss of deltoid/biceps function.

## Brachial Plexus Trunks

Formed in the posterior neck triangle. Upper (C5-C6), middle (C7), and lower (C8-T1) trunks each divide into anterior/posterior divisions behind the clavicle. Upper trunk is most commonly injured in birth injuries (Erb-Duchenne palsy), causing waiter's tip position.

## Brachialis Muscle

Flat strong muscle deep to the biceps, from distal anterior humerus to ulnar tuberosity and coronoid process. Innervated by musculocutaneous nerve (C5-C6). Primary elbow flexor regardless of forearm position ("workhorse" of elbow flexion). Less visible than biceps but significantly contributes to arm strength.

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## Brachiocephalic Trunk

The first and largest branch of the aortic arch. It ascends to the right sternoclavicular joint, where it divides into the right common carotid and right subclavian arteries.

## Brachytherapy

Radiation treatment in which a radioactive source is placed inside or near a tumor to deliver a concentrated dose.

## Brachytherapy Seed

Radioactive source implanted directly into tumor. I-125 or Pd-103 seeds for prostate cancer. Permanent or temporary implantation.

## Bradycardia

A heart rate <60 beats per minute. May be physiologic (athletes) or pathologic due to sinus node dysfunction, AV block, or medication effects. Symptomatic bradycardia causes fatigue, dizziness, syncope, or heart failure. Evaluation includes ECG, Holter monitoring, and assessment of reversible causes.

### Synonyms:

Slow Heartbeat

## Bradycardia Of Prematurity

Heart rate less than 100 beats per minute in a premature infant, often associated with apnea and oxygen desaturation. May be caused by vagal stimulation, reflux, or immaturity of the cardiac conduction system. Treatment: gentle stimulation, caffeine, and addressing underlying causes.

## Bradykinesia

Slowness and reduced amplitude of voluntary movement, often accompanied by difficulty initiating or sustaining repetitive actions. It is a cardinal feature of parkinsonism and may be associated with rigidity, resting tremor, postural instability, reduced arm swing, masked facial expression, and a shuffling gait.

## Bradypnea

Abnormally slow respiratory rate (adult <12 breaths/min). Causes: opioid/benzodiazepine/sedative overdose, central nervous system depression (stroke, trauma, increased ICP), hypothyroidism, hypothermia, and metabolic (e.g., hypokalemia). May lead to hypoventilation, hypercapnia, and respiratory failure.

## Brain

The central organ of the nervous system, enclosed in the cranial cavity and composed of the cerebrum, cerebellum, and brainstem. The brain receives, processes, and integrates sensory information; initiates and coordinates motor responses; and serves as the seat of cognition, emotion, memory, and consciousness.

## Brain Abscess

A focal, purulent infection within the brain parenchyma, most commonly occurring in the frontal or temporal lobes.

## Brain Concussion

A mild traumatic brain injury caused by a blow, jolt, or force that temporarily changes brain function. Symptoms may include headache, dizziness, confusion, memory difficulty, nausea, and sensitivity to light or noise, sometimes without loss of consciousness. Worsening headache, repeated vomiting, seizure, weakness, or increasing drowsiness requires urgent assessment.

## Brain Death

The irreversible cessation of all brain and brainstem function, including consciousness and brainstem reflexes, with absent respiratory drive—a legal definition of death.

## Brain Edema

Swelling caused by excess fluid in brain tissue, which can raise pressure inside the skull. Causes include head injury, stroke, infection, tumor, bleeding, and severe metabolic disturbances. Symptoms may include headache, vomiting, confusion, seizures, weak-



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ness, or reduced consciousness; severe cases are medical emergencies.

### **Brain Health**

Brain health encompasses the ability to perform cognitive functions such as memory, learning, decision-making, and emotional regulation across the lifespan. Key factors include cardiovascular health, nutrition, sleep, social engagement, cognitive stimulation, and management of chronic conditions like hypertension and diabetes.

### **Brain Herniation**

Displacement of brain tissue across rigid intracranial compartments or through the foramen magnum due to mass effect or raised ICP. It can compress the brainstem and cranial nerves and is a life-threatening neurosurgical emergency.

### **Brain Injuries**

Brain injuries range from mild concussions to severe traumatic brain injury caused by falls, motor vehicle accidents, sports impacts, or penetrating trauma. Symptoms depend on injury location and severity, including headache, confusion, memory loss, seizures, and altered consciousness.

### **Brain Injury**

Damage to the brain caused by trauma, lack of oxygen, stroke, infection, toxins, or other disease. Effects depend on the location and severity of injury.

### **Brain Metastases**

Cancer deposits that have spread to the brain from another primary site. They may cause headache, seizures, or focal neurologic deficits.

#### **Synonyms:**

Secondary Brain Cancer

### **Brain Metastasis**

A deposit of cancer that has spread to the brain from another primary site. It may cause headache, seizures, or focal neurologic deficits; treatment depends on the number, location, and biology of the lesions.

### **Brain Monitoring**

Brain monitoring during anesthesia assesses the depth of hypnosis and neurological function. Bispectral index (BIS) processes the frontal EEG into a number from 0 (isoelectric) to 100 (fully awake), with 40 to 60 recommended for general anesthesia. BIS monitoring reduces awareness risk and may reduce anesthetic requirements.

### **Brain Natriuretic Peptide**

A hormone released mainly by the heart ventricles in response to myocardial wall stress. BNP and NT-proBNP can support the assessment of suspected heart failure, but results are affected by age, kidney function, body size, rhythm, and other illnesses and must be interpreted with the clinical findings.

### **Brain SPECT**

Cerebral perfusion imaging using Tc-99m HMPAO or ECD. Used for epilepsy localization, dementia differentiation, cerebrovascular disease.

### **Brain Tumor**

An abnormal growth of cells within the brain or its surrounding structures, classified as primary (originating from brain tissue or its coverings) or secondary/metastatic (spread from a cancer elsewhere in the body, which are more common, accounting for approximately 50 percent of all brain tumors).

### **Brain Ventricles**

The four interconnected fluid-filled cavities within the brain that produce and contain cerebrospinal fluid (CSF).

### **Brainstem**

Connects cerebrum to spinal cord, with midbrain (superior), pons (middle), and medulla oblongata (inferior). Contains cranial nerve nuclei (III-XII), ascending/descending tracts, and vital autonomic centers for cardiac, respiratory, and vasomotor function. Reticular formation regulates consciousness and sleep-wake cycles.

### **Branchial Arch**

One of the paired embryonic arches that contribute



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to development of facial, pharyngeal, laryngeal, muscular, skeletal, vascular, and neural structures of the head and neck.

### **Branchial Cleft**

An embryonic groove between adjacent branchial arches. Persistence of cleft remnants can produce congenital branchial cysts, sinuses, or fistulas, most commonly along the lateral neck.

### **Branchial Cleft Anomaly**

A congenital remnant of the branchial apparatus presenting as a cyst, sinus, or fistula in the head and neck. Recurrent infection or drainage from a persistent opening warrants imaging and specialist management.

### **Branchial Cleft Cyst**

Congenital cystic mass arising from incomplete obliteration of branchial cleft apparatus during embryogenesis.

### **Braxton Hicks Contractions**

Irregular, painless uterine contractions occurring throughout pregnancy, becoming more frequent in the third trimester. Usually last 30-60 seconds and are felt as a tightening of the abdomen. Distinguished from true labour contractions by their irregularity, lack of cervical change, and resolution with rest or hydration.

#### **Synonyms:**

Contractions Braxton-Hicks (Braxton Hicks Contractions) Labor False (Braxton Hicks Contractions)

### **BRCA**

BRCA1 and BRCA2 are tumor-suppressor genes involved in repair of DNA double-strand breaks. Pathogenic variants increase susceptibility to breast, ovarian, fallopian-tube, primary peritoneal, prostate, and pancreatic cancers.

### **BRCA1 And BRCA2**

Tumor-suppressor genes involved in homologous-recombination DNA repair. Germline pathogenic variants increase susceptibility to breast, ovarian, fallopian-tube, primary peritoneal, prostate, and

pancreatic cancers and may guide surveillance and treatment.

### **Breakbone Fever**

A traditional name for dengue fever, reflecting the severe myalgia and arthralgia that may accompany the acute viral illness.

### **Breast Abscess**

A localized collection of pus within the breast tissue, most commonly a complication of lactational mastitis. Presents as a fluctuant, painful mass with overlying erythema and systemic symptoms. Diagnosis by ultrasound. Treatment requires incision and drainage plus antibiotics.

### **Breast Cancer**

A malignant tumor arising in breast tissue. Risk, screening, and treatment depend on age, inherited and acquired biology, stage, and the person's circumstances.

### **Breast Density**

The relative proportion of fibroglandular tissue compared with fat in a breast on mammography. Higher density can make small cancers harder to see and is associated with an increased risk of breast cancer.

### **Breast Cancer Genetics**

The study of inherited variants that increase breast-cancer risk. Important genes and syndromes include BRCA1, BRCA2, PALB2, TP53, PTEN, and CHEK2. Genetic counseling can help determine whether testing is appropriate.

### **Breast Cyst**

A fluid-filled sac within breast tissue, usually benign and sometimes tender or larger before menstruation. Examination and imaging distinguish a cyst from a solid lesion; persistent, growing, bloody, or newly discovered breast lumps should be assessed by a clinician.

### **Breast Discharge**

Fluid released from the nipple without breastfeed-

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ing. It may be caused by hormonal changes, infection, benign duct disease, or cancer. Bloody, clear, spontaneous, one-sided, or persistent discharge, especially with a lump or skin change, requires prompt breast evaluation.

### **Breast Engorgement**

Overfilling of the breasts with milk, causing bilateral pain, firmness, warmth, and nipple flattening. Occurs 3-5 days postpartum. Pathophysiology: vascular congestion and edema before milk secretion is established.

### **Breast Health**

Breast health involves routine self-awareness, clinical examinations, and mammographic screening to detect abnormalities such as lumps, pain, or skin changes that may indicate benign conditions or breast cancer. Risk factors include genetics, age, hormone exposure, and lifestyle factors.

### **Breast Infection**

Infection and inflammation of breast tissue, most commonly mastitis during breastfeeding. It causes localized pain, warmth, redness, swelling, and sometimes fever; an untreated infection may progress to a breast abscess.

### **Breast Lump**

A localized thickening, mass, or swelling in breast tissue caused by a cyst, fibroadenoma, infection, trauma, or malignancy. New, persistent, hard, fixed, or changing lumps require clinical and often imaging assessment.

### **Breast MRI**

Magnetic resonance imaging used to evaluate breast tissue. Contrast may be administered when clinically indicated.

### **Breast Pain**

Pain or tenderness in one or both breasts, caused by hormonal changes, cysts, infection, trauma, medications, or musculoskeletal disease. Persistent focal pain or an associated lump requires assessment.

**Synonyms:**

Pain, Breast

### **Breast Surgery**

Breast cancer surgery: breast-conserving therapy (BCT: lumpectomy + radiation) equivalent survival to mastectomy for early stage. Margins: "no ink on tumor" for invasive cancer; 2mm for DCIS.

### **Breast Ultrasound**

Ultrasound imaging of the breast. Indications: evaluating palpable masses (distinguishing solid vs. cystic), characterizing mammographic abnormalities, guiding biopsy (core needle, fine needle, or vacuum-assisted), evaluating implant integrity, and imaging young/dense breast tissue.

### **Breastfeeding**

The feeding of an infant with breast milk, recommended exclusively for the first 6 months and continued with complementary foods to 2 years and beyond. Benefits: infant (nutrition, immune protection—IgA, reduced infection/allergy/obesity, bonding) and maternal (uterine involution, contraception, reduced breast/ovarian cancer).

### **Breath Sounds**

The sounds produced by airflow through the respiratory tract during breathing, assessed by auscultation with a stethoscope over the chest wall.

### **Breath Stacking**

A technique using a manual resuscitation bag or glosopharyngeal breathing to deliver successive breaths without exhaling, stacking tidal volumes to achieve higher lung volumes. It improves cough effectiveness and secretion clearance in patients with weak respiratory muscles.

### **Breath-Holding Spells**

A benign paroxysmal phenomenon in young children (6 months to 6 years), provoked by frustration, pain, or fear. Cyanotic type (more common): child cries, forcefully exhales, becomes cyanotic, and may lose consciousness briefly.

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### **Breech Delivery**

Vaginal delivery of a breech presentation. Types: assisted breech (the baby delivers spontaneously to the umbilicus, then the operator assists delivery of the shoulders and head) and total breech extraction (the operator delivers the entire baby by grasping the feet and pulling).

### **Breech Presentation**

A fetal presentation where the buttocks or feet are positioned to deliver first. Types include frank breech (hips flexed, knees extended, most common), complete breech (hips and knees flexed), and footling breech (one or both feet presenting). Associated with increased risk of cord prolapse, head entrapment, and birth trauma.

### **Bremsstrahlung**

Braking radiation produced when beta particles decelerate in matter. Continuous spectrum. Detected in I-131 imaging (poor quality). Used for Y-90 bremsstrahlung SPECT.

### **Brenner Tumor**

Rare ovarian epithelial neoplasm (1-2% of ovarian tumors) composed of nests of transitional (urothelial-like) epithelial cells embedded in a dense fibromatous stroma. Most are unilateral, small (< 2 cm), benign (90%) and incidental; borderline (proliferative) and malignant variants are uncommon.

### **Breslow Thickness**

Microstaging measurement of melanoma invasion depth from the top of the granular layer of the epidermis to the deepest point of tumor invasion, in millimeters. Most important prognostic factor in primary cutaneous melanoma, used in the AJCC TNM staging system (T category).

### **Bridge (Dental)**

Fixed prosthetic replacing missing teeth. Retained by adjacent teeth (abutments). Requires preparation of abutments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Brief Psychotic Disorder**

A disturbance characterized by the sudden onset of at least one psychotic symptom: delusions, hallucinations, disorganized speech, or grossly disorganized or catatonic behavior. The disturbance lasts at least one day but less than one month, after which the individual fully returns to premorbid functioning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Psychotic Disorder Brief (Brief Psychotic Disorder)

### **Brief Resolved Unexplained Event**

A sudden, brief, and now-resolved episode in an infant involving abnormal breathing, skin color, muscle tone, or responsiveness, with no explanation after the initial evaluation. Risk assessment is based on age, history, examination findings, and recurrence; higher-risk events require targeted investigation.

### **Bright's Disease**

A historical term encompassing several forms of kidney disease, particularly glomerular disorders associated with proteinuria, edema, and altered urinary findings. Modern diagnosis specifies the underlying renal lesion.

### **Brill's Disease**

A recrudescent form of epidemic typhus caused by reactivation of latent *Rickettsia prowazekii* infection years after the original illness. It is usually milder than the initial infection but can transmit to body lice.

### **Brittle Asthma**

An uncommon term for severe asthma with unusually unpredictable and difficult-to-control airflow or attacks despite appropriate treatment. The term is not a universally standardized diagnostic category; specialist assessment is required to identify triggers, alternative diagnoses, and effective management.

### **Brittle Diabetes**

Labile, unstable type 1 diabetes mellitus characterized by unpredictable, large, recurrent swings in blood glucose between severe hyperglycemia and recurrent hypoglycemia (often with ketoacidosis) despite optimal adherence, significantly disrupting

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quality of life.

### **Broca Aphasia**

Acquired language disorder of expressive speech (motor aphasia) caused by lesion of the posterior inferior frontal gyrus (Broca area, Brodmann area 44/45) of the dominant (usually left) hemisphere, most commonly from middle cerebral artery (MCA) superior division infarction.

### **Broca's Aphasia**

A nonfluent language disorder caused by dysfunction of the dominant inferior frontal language region. Speech is effortful and reduced, while comprehension is relatively preserved compared with repetition and fluent language production.

### **Broca's Area**

A language-related region of the dominant inferior frontal gyrus involved in speech production, language formulation, and aspects of syntax. Lesions may cause expressive aphasia.

### **Broken Finger**

A fracture of one of the finger bones caused by trauma, crushing, or twisting. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, and reduced movement may occur. Assessment should check alignment, tendon function, sensation, and circulation; some fractures require reduction, splinting, or surgery.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pinky Broken Finger (Broken Finger)

### **Broken Foot**

A fracture of one or more bones of the foot, commonly caused by a fall, direct impact, twisting injury, or repetitive stress. Pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty bearing weight are typical. Deformity, an open wound, numbness, or inability to walk requires urgent evaluation and imaging.

### **Broken Heart Syndrome**

A temporary weakening of the heart muscle, often triggered by severe emotional or physical stress. It can resemble a heart attack but usually occurs without an obstructing coronary clot.

### **Broken Toe**

A fracture of a toe bone, usually after direct impact or crushing. Pain, swelling, bruising, and tenderness are common; deformity, an open injury, numbness, or impaired circulation requires prompt assessment. Treatment may include protection and immobilization, with reduction or surgery for displaced or unstable fractures.

#### **Synonyms:**

Toe Broken (Broken Toe)

### **Bromhidrosis**

Excessive or unpleasant body odor produced when microbial metabolism acts on sweat or skin secretions. It is often prominent in the axillae or feet and may be associated with hyperhidrosis or local skin disease.

### **Bromoderma**

A skin eruption or dermatitis attributed to exposure to bromine or bromide compounds. It may present with acneiform, pustular, or other inflammatory lesions.

### **Bronchi**

The major airways conducting air from the trachea into the lungs. The trachea bifurcates at the carina (T4-T5) into right and left main bronchi. The right main bronchus is wider, shorter, and more vertical—aspirated foreign bodies preferentially lodge here.

### **Bronchial Artery**

An artery arising from the systemic circulation that supplies the walls of the bronchi, connective tissue of the lungs, and visceral pleura. It differs from the pulmonary arteries, which carry blood for gas exchange.

### **Bronchial Biopsy**

Tissue sampling of the bronchial wall during bronchoscopy. It is used to diagnose inflammatory conditions (sarcoidosis, eosinophilic bronchitis), infections, and malignancy. Endobronchial biopsy of visible lesions and transbronchial biopsy of parenchymal lesions provide complementary diagnostic informa-

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tion.

### **Bronchial Carcinoid**

Pulmonary neuroendocrine tumor arising from Kulchitsky cells of the bronchial mucosa; subclassified as typical carcinoid (TC, generally lower grade, with fewer mitoses and no necrosis) and atypical carcinoid (AC, generally higher grade, with more mitoses or necrosis and greater risk of recurrence or metastasis).

### **Bronchial Stenosis**

Narrowing of a bronchus from trauma, infection, inflammation, or prior intervention. It causes localized wheezing, recurrent infections, and impaired secretion clearance. Diagnosis is by bronchoscopy. Treatment includes balloon dilation, stenting, or surgical resection.

### **Bronchial Tree**

The branching airway system formed by the trachea, main bronchi, lobar and segmental bronchi, bronchioles, and terminal airways leading toward the alveoli.

### **Bronchial Vein**

A vein draining portions of the bronchial walls and larger airways. It empties partly into the azygos system and partly into pulmonary veins, creating a small physiologic venous admixture.

### **Bronchiectasis**

Permanent, abnormal dilation of bronchi caused by destruction of the bronchial wall from chronic airway inflammation and infection. Causes include CF, immune deficiency, primary ciliary dyskinesia, and post-infectious damage. Features include chronic cough, copious purulent sputum, and recurrent hemoptysis.

### **Bronchiole**

Small airways (less than 2 mm diameter) without cartilage, branching from segmental bronchi to terminal bronchioles (conducting zone) to respiratory bronchioles (transitional, alveoli bud from walls) to alveolar ducts to alveolar sacs to alveoli.

### **Bronchiolectasis**

Permanent abnormal dilation of bronchioles, usually caused by chronic inflammation, infection, or obstruction. It may accompany bronchiectasis and contribute to impaired mucus clearance and recurrent infection.

### **Bronchiolitis**

Lower respiratory tract infection causing inflammation and obstruction of small airways. Most common cause is respiratory syncytial virus. Affects infants under 12 months. Presents with wheezing, tachypnea, nasal flaring, and retractions. Diagnosis is clinical.

### **Bronchiolitis Obliterans**

An uncommon, often irreversible obstructive small-airway disease caused by inflammation and fibrotic narrowing or obliteration of the bronchioles. Causes include severe infection, inhalational injury, autoimmune disease, and complications after lung or bone-marrow transplantation.

### **Bronchitis**

Inflammation of the bronchial mucosa. Acute bronchitis is typically viral, presents with cough (often productive), and resolves spontaneously. Cough with sputum production for at least 3 months in 2 consecutive years, often due to smoking.

### **Bronchoalveolar Lavage**

Diagnostic procedure during bronchoscopy where saline is instilled and aspirated. Analyzed for cell counts, microbiology, and cytology. Useful for *Pneumocystis pneumonia*, pulmonary alveolar proteinosis, and sarcoidosis diagnosis.

### **Bronchodilator Response**

The change in spirometric airflow after administration of a short-acting bronchodilator. A significant response can support variable airflow limitation, but a negative response does not exclude asthma and a positive response is not specific to one disease.

### **Bronchodilator Reversibility**

Improvement in airflow measurements after an in-



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haled bronchodilator. A measurable increase may support variable airway obstruction, but no single response proves or excludes asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

### **Bronchoesophageal Fistula**

Abnormal communication between the bronchial tree and the esophagus, most commonly acquired from malignancy, mediastinal infection, or tuberculous lymphadenitis. Congenital forms are associated with esophageal atresia.

### **Bronchogenic Cyst**

A congenital cyst derived from abnormal budding of the ventral foregut. It is typically found in the middle mediastinum or near the carina. It is usually asymptomatic but may cause compression of adjacent structures. Treatment is surgical resection if symptomatic.

### **Bronchophony**

Increased transmission of spoken sounds to the stethoscope over consolidated lung tissue. It is normally heard over the central airways. Excessive bronchophony over peripheral lung fields indicates consolidation. It is part of the constellation of physical examination findings in pneumonia.

### **Bronchopleural Fistula**

An abnormal communication between the bronchial tree and pleural space. It is a complication of pneumonectomy, lung surgery, or empyema. It causes persistent air leak, subcutaneous emphysema, and respiratory compromise. Treatment includes chest tube drainage, bronchoscopic intervention, and surgical repair.

### **Bronchopneumonia**

Patchy consolidation centered on bronchioles across multiple lobes. Caused by *S. aureus*, gram-negative bacteria, and *Pseudomonas*.

### **Bronchopulmonary Dysplasia**

A chronic lung disease of premature infants, resulting from lung injury from mechanical ventilation, oxygen toxicity, and inflammation. Most commonly

occurs in infants born at less than 28 weeks gestation with birth weight less than 1500 grams.

### **Bronchoscopy**

Endoscopic examination of the tracheobronchial tree. Flexible bronchoscopy: most common, for diagnosis (lung mass, persistent cough, hemoptysis, suspected infection, ILD) and therapy (foreign body removal, bronchial washing, biopsy, BAL). Rigid bronchoscopy: for massive hemoptysis, large foreign bodies, and stent placement.

### **Bronchospasm**

Involuntary constriction of bronchial smooth muscle causing airway obstruction, wheezing, and increased airway pressures. Triggers include airway manipulation, volatile anesthetics (sevoflurane is bronchodilating; desflurane can cause bronchospasm), histamine-releasing drugs (morphine, atracurium), and reactive airway disease.

### **Bronchostenosis**

Narrowing of a bronchus that restricts airflow. Causes include scarring, tumors, foreign bodies, inflammation, external compression, or postinfectious and postprocedural changes.

### **Bronchus**

One of the two main branches of the trachea that conduct air into the lungs. The right main bronchus is wider, shorter, and more vertical than the left, making it more susceptible to aspiration. Each main bronchus divides into lobar bronchi (secondary), segmental bronchi (tertiary), and progressively smaller branches (bronchioles).

### **Bronze Diabetes**

Historical eponym for hereditary hemochromatosis (HFE-related HH, C282Y homozygous mutation), characterized by the classic triad of skin pigmentation ("bronze"), cirrhosis, and diabetes mellitus from pancreatic iron deposition. Also known as "Troisier syndrome" or pigment cirrhosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

"Troisier syndrome" or pigment cirrhosis.



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### **Brow Presentation**

A fetal presentation where the fetal head is in a military position between full flexion (vertex) and hyperextension (face). The presenting diameter is the largest (occipitofrontal, 13.5 cm). Incidence: 1:1000-1:2000. Vaginal delivery is impossible with a persistent brow in a term fetus unless it converts to vertex or face.

### **Brown Lung Disease**

An occupational airway disease associated with inhalation of cotton, flax, or hemp dust, classically causing byssinosis. Symptoms may include chest tightness, cough, wheezing, and work-related airflow limitation.

### **Brown Sequard Syndrome**

Brown-Sequard syndrome (hemisection of the spinal cord) results from a lesion affecting one half of the spinal cord, producing a characteristic pattern of ipsilateral and contralateral neurological deficits.

### **Brown Stain**

Extrinsic staining from chromogenic bacteria, diet, tobacco. Removed by prophylaxis.

### **Brucellosis**

A zoonotic infection caused by *Brucella* bacteria, transmitted through contact with infected animals or consumption of unpasteurized animal products. It commonly causes fever, sweats, fatigue, and joint or muscle pain.

### **Brudzinski Sign**

Flexion of the hips and knees that occurs involuntarily when the neck is passively flexed. It is a meningeal irritation sign that may occur in meningitis but lacks sufficient sensitivity or specificity to establish the diagnosis alone.

### **Brugada Syndrome**

A genetic channelopathy causing abnormal sodium channel function (SCN5A mutation). ECG pattern: coved ST elevation >2mm in V1-V3 (type 1) followed by negative T wave. Patients are at risk for ventricular fibrillation and sudden cardiac death, of-

ten at rest or during sleep. More common in young Southeast Asian men.

### **Bruise**

A contusion: localized hemorrhage into tissues due to blunt force trauma rupturing small blood vessels, with intact skin.

### **Bruising**

Ecchymosis/contusion: a purplish-blue discoloration from blood extravasation into skin/subcutaneous tissue following trauma; color changes with age (red-blue purple green/yellow—bilirubin breakdown).

### **Brunner's Gland**

A mucus-secreting gland in the submucosa of the duodenum. Its alkaline secretion helps protect the mucosa from gastric acid and provides conditions favorable for intestinal enzymes.

### **Bruxism**

Grinding or clenching teeth, often during sleep. Causes: stress, occlusion, sleep disorders. Consequences: tooth wear, fractures, muscle pain, TMJ disorders. Treatment: occlusal guard, stress management, behavior modification.

### **Synonyms:**

Teeth Grinding (Bruxism)

### **Buccal Gland**

A minor salivary gland located in the cheek. It secretes mucus into the oral cavity to lubricate the buccal mucosa and assist formation and handling of the food bolus.

### **Budd-Chiari Syndrome**

Obstruction of hepatic venous outflow at any level from small hepatic venules to the inferior vena cava junction with the right atrium. The most common predisposing condition is myeloproliferative disorders accounting for forty to fifty percent of cases. Other risk factors include thrombophilia and oral contraceptive use.

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## Buerger Disease

An inflammatory disorder of small and medium arteries and veins, strongly associated with tobacco use, that can cause limb ischemia and tissue loss.

## Buerger's Disease

Thromboangiitis obliterans, a nonatherosclerotic inflammatory disease of small and medium arteries and veins, strongly associated with tobacco exposure. It causes distal ischemia, pain, ulcers, and sometimes gangrene.

## Buffer

A solution that resists pH change upon addition of acid or base, composed of a weak acid and its conjugate base (or weak base and conjugate acid). Buffer capacity is maximal when  $\text{pH} = \text{pK}_a \pm 1$ .

## Bulbar Conjunctiva

The bulbar conjunctiva is the portion of the conjunctival membrane that covers the anterior surface of the sclera, extending from the limbus (the junction of the cornea and sclera) to the fornices where it reflects onto the inner surface of the eyelids.

## Bulbar Paralysis

Weakness or paralysis of muscles supplied by the lower cranial nerves, causing dysarthria, dysphagia, impaired gag or cough, and sometimes respiratory compromise. Causes include brainstem disease, motor-neuron disease, and neuromuscular disorders.

## Bulimia Nervosa

An eating disorder characterized by recurrent episodes of binge eating followed by compensatory behaviors (purging, laxatives, excessive exercise). Self-esteem overly influenced by body shape and weight.

### Synonyms:

Eating Disorders, Bulimia

## Bullae

Large, fluid-filled blisters that form within or beneath the skin or mucous membrane. Causes include friction, burns, infection, allergy, and autoimmune

disease.

## Bullet Track

The path a projectile traverses through the body, defined by the entry wound, internal course (through organs, vessels, bones), and exit wound (or retained bullet).

## Bullous Impetigo

A superficial staphylococcal skin infection caused by exfoliative toxins that produce fragile, flaccid bullae and honey-coloured or varnish-like crusts, especially in infants and young children.

## Bullous Pemphigoid

An autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease affecting elderly patients. It presents with tense blisters on erythematous or normal-appearing skin, often preceded by pruritic urticarial plaques. Autoantibodies target BP180 and BP230 (hemidesmosome proteins).

### Synonyms:

Pemphigoid Bullous (Bullous Pemphigoid)

## Bumetanide

A potent loop diuretic inhibiting the Na-K-2Cl co-transporter in the thick ascending limb of the loop of Henle. Used for edema in heart failure, cirrhosis, and renal disease, and for hypertension in renal impairment. Approximately 40 times more potent than furosemide; more bioavailable orally, so equivalent IV-to-oral dosing is possible.

## Bundle Branch Block

Delay or block in the electrical conduction through the bundle branches. Left Bundle Branch Block (LBBB): QRS  $>120$  ms, broad notched R waves in lateral leads (I, V5-V6), deep S waves in V1-V2. Right Bundle Branch Block (RBBB): QRS  $>120$  ms, rSR' pattern in V1-V2, wide S waves in I, V5-V6.

## Bundle Of His

A narrow band of specialized cardiac tissue that conducts electrical impulses from the AV node through the fibrous cardiac skeleton to the interventricular septum. It divides into the right and left bundle

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branches. The bundle of His is the only electrical connection between atria and ventricles through the fibrous skeleton.

### **Bunion**

A bony prominence (exostosis) at the medial aspect of the first metatarsal head, causing lateral deviation of the great toe (hallux valgus). The deformity is characterized by a structural abnormality at the first metatarsophalangeal joint, with the first metatarsal deviating medially and the proximal phalanx deviating laterally.

### **Bunionectomy**

Surgical correction of hallux valgus (bunion) deformity, indicated for symptomatic bunions refractory to conservative measures (proper footwear, orthoses, toe spacers, NSAIDs). Procedure chosen based on severity (hallux valgus angle and intermetatarsal angle) and patient factors (age, activity, comorbidities).

### **Buphthalmos**

Enlargement of the eye caused by elevated intraocular pressure during early childhood, when the ocular coats are still distensible. It is classically associated with congenital or infantile glaucoma.

### **Burkitt Lymphoma**

A highly aggressive B-cell lymphoma characterized by MYC translocation (t(8;14) IGH-MYC, t(8;22) IGL-MYC, t(2;8) IGK-MYC) and a "starry sky" morphology (tingible body macrophages). Three variants: endemic (African, EBV+, jaw/facial bones), sporadic (abdominal, ileocecal), immunodeficiency-associated (HIV).

#### **Synonyms:**

Burkitt's Tumor

### **Burn**

An injury to skin or deeper tissue caused by heat, chemicals, electricity, radiation, or friction. Severity depends on depth, extent, location, and associated injury.

### **Burn (Oral)**

Thermal or chemical injury to the lining of the mouth, often causing pain, redness, or ulceration. Severity depends on the substance, temperature, depth, and extent of injury.

#### **Synonyms:**

Oral

### **Burn Surgery**

Burn assessment: rule of 9s (adult), Lund-Browder (children). Depth: superficial (epidermis), superficial partial (dermis, blanch, blister, painful), deep partial (deeper dermis, white, sluggish capillary refill, less painful), full thickness (all dermis, white/charred, anesthetic).

### **Burning Mouth Syndrome**

A chronic oral pain disorder causing daily burning, scalding, or tingling discomfort in the mouth, often involving the tongue, lips, or palate, usually with a normal-appearing mucosa. Altered taste or dry mouth may occur. It may be primary, with no identifiable cause, or secondary to conditions or exposures such as nutritional deficiency, oral infection, medication effects, allergy, diabetes, or hormonal change; evaluation should exclude treatable causes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Scalded Mouth Syndrome Stomatodynia

### **Bursectomy**

Surgical excision of a bursa, usually performed for persistent painful bursitis, recurrent infection, or another structural problem that has not responded to appropriate conservative management.

### **Bursitis**

Inflammation of a bursa, a fluid-filled sac that reduces friction between tendons, muscles, bones, and skin. Bursae are lined by synovial cells and normally contain a thin layer of lubricating synovial fluid.

### **Button Magnets In The Nasal Cavity**

Ingestion or insertion of small magnets into the nose, posing a risk of nasal septal perforation or necrosis if multiple magnets are involved, requiring urgent removal.

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## **Bypass**

Surgical creation of alternative route around blocked vessel. Uses vein or prosthetic graft.

## **Bypass (Vascular)**

Surgical procedure creating detour around blocked vessel using autologous vein (saphenous) or prosthetic graft (PTFE, Dacron). See Bypass Graft.

### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

## **Bypass Graft**

Surgical procedure creating detour around blocked vessel using autologous vein (saphenous) or prosthetic graft (PTFE, Dacron). Indications: peripheral arterial disease, coronary artery disease, aortic aneurysm. Long-term patency depends on graft type, inflow/outflow, patient factors.

## **Bypass Surgery**

A surgical conduit that reroutes flow around an obstructed or diseased segment, applied to coronary arteries (CABG), peripheral arteries (autologous vein or prosthetic bypass), and the gastrointestinal tract (gastric bypass). Principal long-term concerns are conduit patency, graft infection, and anastomotic stenosis.

## **Byssinosis**

An occupational obstructive airway disease caused by inhalation of textile fibers, especially cotton, flax, or hemp dust. It may cause chest tightness and cough that worsen during or after work exposure.

## **Baroreflex**

A rapid reflex that helps regulate blood pressure by adjusting heart rate and blood-vessel tone in response to changes in arterial pressure.

## **Bartter Disease**

A group of inherited kidney disorders that cause excessive loss of salt and potassium in the urine.

## **Behcet Syndrome**

A chronic inflammatory disorder that can cause re-

current mouth and genital ulcers, eye inflammation, and other organ involvement.

## **Beta Thalassemia**

An inherited blood disorder in which reduced production of beta-globin causes anemia.

## **Brachial Plexus Neuropathies**

Disorders caused by injury or dysfunction of the network of nerves supplying the shoulder and arm.

## **Brain Stem Glioma**

A tumor arising from glial cells in the brainstem.

## **Breakthrough Pain**

A temporary flare of severe pain that occurs despite otherwise controlled persistent pain.

## **Bundle-Branch Block**

Delayed or interrupted electrical conduction through one of the heart's ventricular bundle branches.

## **Burkitt's Lymphoma**

A rapidly growing type of non-Hodgkin lymphoma arising from B lymphocytes.

## **Beach Chair Position**

A semisitting position in which the patient's back is elevated and the hips and knees are flexed; it is commonly used for shoulder surgery.

## **Balloon Angioplasty**

A procedure that uses an inflatable balloon catheter to widen a narrowed artery, often followed by stent placement.

## **Barrett's Esophagus**

A change in the lower esophageal lining caused by chronic reflux and associated with an increased risk of esophageal adenocarcinoma.

### **Synonyms:**

Barretts Esophagus (Barrett's Esophagus) Columnar Epithelium Lined Lower Esophagus

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### **Basilar Artery**

The artery formed by the union of the vertebral arteries that supplies the brainstem, cerebellum, and posterior brain.

### **Beta Cells**

Pancreatic cells that produce and release insulin.

### **Bile**

A fluid produced by the liver that helps digest and absorb dietary fats.

### **Bilevel Positive Airway Pressure**

Noninvasive ventilation that provides different pressures during inhalation and exhalation to support breathing.

### **Bisphosphonate**

A medicine that reduces bone breakdown and is used to prevent or treat osteoporosis and some other bone disorders.

### **Blood Urea Nitrogen Test**

A blood test that measures urea nitrogen and helps assess kidney function and hydration.

### **Brain Stem**

The lower part of the brain connecting the cerebrum with the spinal cord and controlling essential functions such as breathing and consciousness.

### **Bronchodilator**

A medicine that relaxes airway muscle and widens the airways to improve breathing.

### **Bruit**

An abnormal sound heard over a blood vessel, usually with a stethoscope, caused by turbulent blood flow.

### **Bursa**

A small fluid-filled sac that reduces friction between moving tissues near a joint.

### **Baby Acne**

Small red or white bumps on an infant's skin, usually caused by temporary hormonal effects and often resolving without treatment.

### **Bad Breath**

An unpleasant odor of the breath, medically called halitosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Breath Bad (Bad Breath)

### **Bags Under Eyes**

Mild swelling or fullness beneath the eyes, commonly related to aging, fluid retention, or inherited anatomy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Puffy Eyes

### **Balance Problems**

Difficulty maintaining body stability while standing or moving, often caused by disorders of the inner ear, nervous system, vision, or muscles.

### **Bardet-Biedl Syndrome**

A rare inherited disorder that may cause retinal degeneration, obesity, extra fingers or toes, kidney disease, and reproductive abnormalities.

### **Bartholin's Cyst**

A fluid-filled cyst caused by blockage of a Bartholin gland near the vaginal opening.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst, Bartholin's

### **Bile Duct Cancer**

Cancer arising in the bile ducts; also called cholangiocarcinoma.

#### **Synonyms:**

cholangiocarcinoma.

### **Binge-Eating Disorder**

A disorder marked by recurrent episodes of eating unusually large amounts of food with a sense of loss of control and without regular compensatory behaviors.

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**Synonyms:**

Compulsive Overeating Eating Disorders, Binge Eating

**Blastocystis Hominis**

A microscopic organism that can inhabit the intestinal tract; its role in causing gastrointestinal symptoms is variable and sometimes uncertain.

**Synonyms:**

Blastocystosis

**Blocked Tear Duct**

Partial or complete blockage of the passage that drains tears from the eye into the nose.

**Boils And Carbuncles**

Painful skin infections caused by pus-filled inflammation around hair follicles; a carbuncle is a connected group of boils.

**Synonyms:**

Carbuncles And Boils

**Bone Spurs**

Bony projections that form along the edges of bones, usually near joints, often because of long-term wear or arthritis.

**Synonyms:**

Osteophytes

**B-Cell Lymphoma**

A group of lymphatic cancers arising from B lymphocytes.

**Brainstem Tumor**

A tumor arising in the brainstem, the part of the brain that connects the cerebrum with the spinal cord.

**Babcock Clamp**

An atraumatic surgical clamp with fenestrated jaws used to hold delicate tubular tissue.

**Bone Saw**

A surgical saw used to cut bone during procedures such as amputation or orthopedic reconstruction.

**Body Surface Area**

An estimate of the total external surface area of the body, calculated from height and weight and used in some medication dosing and physiologic calculations.

**Bolus**

A discrete amount of medication or fluid given over a short period, usually by injection or infusion. In digestion, a bolus is chewed food ready to be swallowed.

**Bougie**

A slender, flexible instrument used to examine or gradually dilate a narrowed tubular structure, such as the esophagus or urethra.

**Bronchoscope**

A thin, lighted instrument used to examine the trachea and bronchi and, when needed, obtain tissue or fluid samples.

**Bacillary Dysentery**

Acute inflammatory diarrhea caused by *Shigella* species, typically producing fever, abdominal cramps, and frequent stools that may contain blood or mucus.

**Bacillus Anthracis**

The spore-forming bacterium that causes anthrax. Infection may be cutaneous, gastrointestinal, or inhalational.

**Bacillus Cereus**

A spore-forming bacterium that can cause food poisoning, usually through a rapid-onset vomiting syndrome or a diarrheal syndrome after ingestion of contaminated food.

**Bacteriostasis**

Inhibition of bacterial growth and reproduction without necessarily killing the bacteria.

**Bacteriostatic**

Describing an agent or condition that inhibits bac-



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terial growth rather than directly killing bacteria.

### **Bartonella**

A genus of bacteria that includes organisms causing cat-scratch disease, trench fever, bacillary angiomatosis, and other infections.

### **Batten Disease**

An inherited group of neuronal ceroid lipofuscinoses causing progressive neurodegeneration, seizures, vision loss, and cognitive or motor decline, usually beginning in childhood.

### **Bednar Aphthae**

Traumatic ulcers on the posterior palate of an infant, often associated with pressure or irritation during feeding.

### **Balloon Tamponade**

Temporary control of bleeding or obstruction using an inflatable balloon catheter to apply pressure or occlude a passage. Examples include tamponade of variceal bleeding, postpartum hemorrhage, or selected vascular injuries.

### **Bacterial Pharyngitis**

Infection and inflammation of the pharynx caused by bacteria, most commonly group A *Streptococcus*. Symptoms may include sore throat, fever, painful swallowing, and tender cervical lymph nodes.

### **Bacterial Peritonitis**

Infection of the peritoneal cavity, which may occur spontaneously in patients with ascites or secondarily after perforation, surgery, or another intra-abdominal infection. It requires prompt evaluation and antimicrobial treatment.

### **Bacillus**

A rod-shaped bacterium. The term may refer broadly to bacterial shape or specifically to members of the genus *Bacillus*, some of which form resistant spores and cause human disease.

### **Baroreceptor**

A pressure-sensitive sensory receptor, mainly in the carotid sinus and aortic arch, that detects arterial-wall stretch and helps regulate blood pressure through autonomic reflexes.

### **Barrier Nursing (Isolation Nursing)**

Nursing care arranged to reduce the spread of infection between a patient, healthcare workers, and other patients by using appropriate hand hygiene, protective equipment, and isolation measures.

#### **Synonyms:**

Isolation Nursing

### **Basilic Vein**

A superficial vein of the upper limb that ascends along the medial side of the arm and joins the brachial veins to form the axillary vein. It is used for venous access in selected settings.

### **Basophilia**

An abnormally increased number of basophils in the blood. It may occur with myeloproliferative disorders, allergic or inflammatory conditions, and some infections.

### **Biochemistry**

The study of the chemical substances and reactions occurring in living organisms. Clinical biochemistry uses laboratory measurements to assess health and disease.

### **Biofeedback**

A technique that provides information about a physiological process, such as muscle activity, heart rate, or breathing, to help a person learn voluntary control of it.

### **Biological Warfare**

The deliberate use of microorganisms, toxins, or other biological agents to cause disease or death in humans, animals, or plants.

### **Birth Defect (Congenital Anomaly)**

A structural, functional, or metabolic abnormality

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present at birth, caused by genetic, environmental, nutritional, infectious, or multifactorial factors.

**Synonyms:**

Congenital Anomaly

**Birth Asphyxia**

Inadequate oxygenation or ventilation around the time of birth, potentially causing respiratory failure, metabolic acidosis, organ injury, or hypoxic-ischaemic encephalopathy. It requires immediate neonatal assessment and resuscitation.

**Birth Rate**

The number of live births in a population during a specified period, usually expressed per 1,000 people per year.

**Blackwater Fever**

A severe form of malaria, classically associated with *Plasmodium falciparum*, characterized by intravascular hemolysis, hemoglobinuria, anemia, and possible kidney failure.

**Blood Donor**

A person who voluntarily gives blood or blood components for transfusion or medical use. Donors are screened to protect both donor health and recipient safety.

**Blood Poisoning (Septicaemia)**

An older term commonly used for serious bloodstream infection or sepsis. Sepsis is life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated response to infection.

**Synonyms:**

Septicaemia

**Blood Vessels**

Tubular structures that transport blood through the body, including arteries, arterioles, capillaries, venules, and veins.

**B-Mode Ultrasound**

Brightness-mode ultrasonography, which produces a two-dimensional image from echoes returning from

tissues. It is the standard imaging mode for many organs and soft tissues.

**Borborygmi**

Rumbling or gurgling sounds produced by the movement of gas and fluid through the intestines. They may be normal or altered in gastrointestinal obstruction and other disorders.

**Bow Legs (Genu Varum)**

Outward curvature of the legs so that the knees remain apart when the ankles are together. It may be a normal developmental stage in young children or result from bone disease.

**Synonyms:**

Genu Varum

**Breast Examination**

Systematic inspection and palpation of the breasts and regional lymph nodes to assess masses, skin or nipple changes, pain, or other abnormalities.

**Breast Milk**

Milk produced by the mammary glands after childbirth, providing nutrients, immune factors, and other substances important for infant growth and development.

**Breast Reconstruction**

Surgical restoration of breast shape after mastectomy or trauma, using an implant, the patient's own tissue, or a combination of techniques.

**Breast Screening**

Examination of people without breast symptoms to detect breast cancer at an earlier stage, most commonly using mammography according to age and risk-based programs.

**Breathlessness (Dyspnoea)**

The uncomfortable awareness of difficult, labored, or insufficient breathing. Causes include respiratory, cardiac, metabolic, and psychological disorders.

**Synonyms:**

Dyspnoea

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## Bubo

A tender, enlarged lymph node, usually in the groin, armpit, or neck, caused by infection. Buboes are classically associated with plague but occur in other infections.

## B Cell

A lymphocyte that develops in the bone marrow and can differentiate into antibody-producing plasma cells or memory B cells after activation.

### Synonyms:

B lymphocyte; B-cell.

## Balloon Dilation

A procedure that widens a narrowed body passage or vessel by inflating a balloon at the affected site.

### Synonyms:

Balloon dilatation; balloon angioplasty when performed in a blood vessel.

## Baseline EKG

An electrocardiogram obtained for comparison with later tracings or before a treatment, procedure, or change in clinical status.

### Synonyms:

Baseline ECG; reference electrocardiogram.

## Benign

Not malignant and not expected to invade nearby tissue or spread to distant sites, although a benign lesion can still cause problems because of its size or location.

### Synonyms:

Nonmalignant; noncancerous.

## Benign Orgasmic Headache

A sudden severe headache occurring during sexual activity or at orgasm after dangerous secondary causes have been excluded.

### Synonyms:

Primary headache associated with sexual activity; sexual-activity headache.

## Bernstein Test

A historical provocative test in which acid is intro-

duced into the esophagus to reproduce heartburn symptoms; it has largely been replaced by more direct evaluation of reflux.

### Synonyms:

Acid perfusion test; Bernstein acid perfusion test.

## Beta Agonists

Drugs that activate beta-adrenergic receptors, producing effects such as relaxation of airway smooth muscle or increased cardiac stimulation depending on receptor selectivity.

### Synonyms:

Beta-adrenergic agonists; beta-agonist drugs.

## Beta Amyloid

Peptides generated from amyloid precursor protein that can accumulate as plaques in the brain in Alzheimer disease.

### Synonyms:

Amyloid-beta; A-beta peptide.

## Beta Carotene

A carotenoid pigment found in plants that can be converted by the body into vitamin A.

### Synonyms:

Beta-carotene; provitamin A carotenoid.

## Biguanides

A class of glucose-lowering medicines that reduce hepatic glucose production and improve insulin sensitivity; metformin is the principal example.

### Synonyms:

Biguanide drugs; biguanide antidiabetics.

## Binge Drinking

A pattern of consuming enough alcohol over a short period to produce a high blood alcohol concentration and increased risk of injury or acute toxicity.

### Synonyms:

Episodic heavy drinking; heavy episodic drinking.

## Binocular Vision

Vision that uses both eyes together to produce a single image and support depth perception.

### Synonyms:

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Two-eyed vision; binocular visual function.

### **Binswanger's Dementia**

A form of vascular cognitive impairment caused by diffuse small-vessel disease affecting the brain's deep white matter.

#### **Synonyms:**

Subcortical ischemic vascular disease; subcortical arteriosclerotic encephalopathy.

### **Biochanin A**

A naturally occurring isoflavone found mainly in legumes and other plants. It is studied for biologic effects but is not established as a treatment for disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Biochanin A isoflavone; 5,7-dihydroxy-4'-methoxyisoflavone.

### **Biochemical Recurrence**

A rise in a disease-specific laboratory marker after treatment, suggesting recurrent or persistent disease before clinical or imaging findings become apparent.

#### **Synonyms:**

Biochemical relapse; biochemical failure.

### **Biological Variability**

Natural variation in a measured biologic quantity within the same person over time or between people, independent of measurement error.

#### **Synonyms:**

Biologic variation; physiologic variability.

### **Blackout**

A period of partial or complete memory loss, commonly associated with alcohol or other causes of impaired consciousness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Amnestic episode; alcohol-related amnesia when caused by alcohol.

### **Bladder Neck**

The narrow lower part of the urinary bladder where it connects to the urethra and contributes to urinary continence.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vesical neck; bladder outlet.

### **Blister**

A fluid-filled elevation between or within layers of skin or mucosa, caused by friction, burns, infection, allergy, or an autoimmune blistering disorder.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bulla; vesicle when small.

### **Blocking Agent**

A substance that prevents or reduces a biologic process by blocking a receptor, channel, enzyme, or other target.

#### **Synonyms:**

Blocker; antagonist when it acts by receptor antagonism.

### **BMD**

A measurement of bone mineral content adjusted for area, used to assess bone strength and help diagnose osteoporosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bone mineral density; bone density.

### **BMI**

A weight-to-height index calculated as weight in kilograms divided by height in meters squared. It is used as a population-level measure related to body size, not as a complete individual health assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Body mass index; Quetelet index.

### **Body Mass Index**

A weight-to-height index calculated as weight in kilograms divided by height in meters squared. It is used to classify weight categories in populations and clinical screening.

#### **Synonyms:**

BMI; Quetelet index.

### **Bone Mass**

The amount of mineralized bone tissue in the skeleton or in a specified region.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Bone mineral content; skeletal bone mass.

### **Bone Mineral Density**

The concentration of mineral in bone, usually measured by dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry to assess fracture risk and osteoporosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

BMD; bone density.

### **Bouchard's Nodes**

Firm bony enlargements of the proximal interphalangeal joints, most commonly caused by hand osteoarthritis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Proximal interphalangeal osteophytes; PIP-joint nodes.

### **Bowel**

The small and large intestines, which receive digested food, absorb nutrients and water, and form and transport stool.

#### **Synonyms:**

Intestine; intestinal tract.

### **Brain Imaging**

Medical imaging used to examine brain structure or function, including CT, MRI, vascular imaging, and selected nuclear medicine techniques.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neuroimaging; cerebral imaging.

### **Brain Waves**

Electrical activity generated by the coordinated firing of neurons and recorded by electroencephalography.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cerebral electrical activity; EEG rhythms.

### **Breast Augmentation**

Surgery or another procedure intended to increase breast volume or alter breast shape, commonly using an implant or transferred tissue.

#### **Synonyms:**

Breast enlargement; augmentation mammoplasty.

### **Breath Focus**

A mindfulness or relaxation practice that uses attention to breathing to stabilize awareness and reduce physiological or emotional arousal.

#### **Synonyms:**

Breath-focused meditation; breathing-focused mindfulness.

### **Bronchial Tubes**

The right and left main bronchi and their branches that conduct air from the trachea into the lungs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bronchi; bronchial tree when referring to the branching airway system.

### **Bunionette**

A painful prominence at the outer side of the fifth metatarsophalangeal joint, often associated with footwear pressure or altered foot mechanics.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tailor's bunion; bunion of the fifth toe.

### **Babesia**

A genus of intraerythrocytic protozoan parasites transmitted mainly by Ixodes ticks; infection (babesiosis) can cause fever, haemolytic anaemia, thrombocytopenia, and severe disease in people without a spleen or with impaired immunity.

### **Babesia Divergens**

*Babesia divergens* is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Babesia Microti**

*Babesia microti* is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillaceae**

Bacillaceae is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical

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context.

### **Bacillus Lentus**

Bacillus lentus is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillus Licheniformis**

Bacillus licheniformis is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillus Megaterium**

Bacillus megaterium is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillus Mycoides**

Bacillus mycoides is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillus Pumilus**

Bacillus pumilus is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacillus Subtilis**

Bacillus subtilis is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bacitracin**

Bacitracin is a topical polypeptide antibiotic that interferes with bacterial cell-wall synthesis and is used for selected superficial infections.

### **Baclofen**

Baclofen is a medication or pharmacologic agent;

its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Bacteria Present**

Bacteria present is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacterial Protein**

Bacterial protein is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacterial Toxemia**

Bacterial toxemia is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacterial Toxin**

Bacterial toxin is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacterial Typing**

Bacterial typing is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacterial Vaccine**

Bacterial vaccine is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteriocin**

Bacteriocin is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.



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### **Bacteriophage Lambda**

Bacteriophage lambda is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteriophage T4**

Bacteriophage t4 is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteriophages**

Bacteriophages is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteriorhodopsin**

Bacteriorhodopsin is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroidaceae**

Bacteroidaceae is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides**

Bacteroides is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Caccae**

Bacteroides caccae is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Dorei**

Bacteroides dorei is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on

the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Eggerthii**

Bacteroides eggerthii is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Faecis**

Bacteroides faecis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Fragilis**

Bacteroides fragilis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Gingivalis**

Bacteroides gingivalis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Heparinolyticus**

Bacteroides heparinolyticus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Intestinalis**

Bacteroides intestinalis is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Bacteroides Nordii**

Bacteroides nordii is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

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### **Bacteroides Ovatus**

Bacteroides ovatus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Pyogenes**

Bacteroides pyogenes is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Salyersiae**

Bacteroides salyersiae is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Stercoris**

Bacteroides stercoris is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Thetaiotaomicron**

Bacteroides thetaiotaomicron is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Uniformis**

Bacteroides uniformis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Ureolyticus**

Bacteroides ureolyticus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Vulgatus**

Bacteroides vulgatus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on

the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroides Xylanisolvens**

Bacteroides xylanisolvens is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bacteroidete**

Bacteroidete is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Baculoviridae**

Baculoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Bad Protein**

Bad protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Bak Protein**

Bak protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Balamuthia**

A biomedical term referring to balamuthia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Balamuthia Mandrillaris**

A biomedical term referring to balamuthia mandrillaris; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

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## Balanced Study

Balanced study is used in relation to balanced study during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Balantidiasis

Balantidiasis is intestinal infection caused by the protozoan *Balantidium coli*, producing diarrhea, abdominal pain, or colitis, especially after fecal exposure.

## Balantidium

A biomedical term referring to *balantidium*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Balantidium Coli

A biomedical term referring to *balantidium coli*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Balbani Body

A specialized aggregate of organelles, including mitochondria and messenger RNA, near the nucleus of a developing oocyte; it helps organize maternal determinants during early embryonic development.

## Balloon Brachytherapy

Balloon brachytherapy is used in relation to balloon brachytherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Balloon Dilatation

Balloon dilatation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## Barakat Syndrome

A clinical disorder or finding related to barakat syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## Barbiturates

Barbiturates is used in relation to barbiturates during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Barium Sulfate

An insoluble radiopaque contrast agent used for radiographic examinations of the gastrointestinal tract; aspiration or leakage from the bowel can cause serious complications.

## Barlow Test

Barlow test is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## Bartonella Elizabethae

A biomedical term referring to *bartonella elizabethae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Bartonella Henselae

A biomedical term referring to *bartonella henselae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Bartonella Infections

A biomedical term referring to *bartonella* infections; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Bartonella Quintana

A biomedical term referring to *bartonella quintana*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Bartonellaceae

Bartonellaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen

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source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bart's Hemoglobinopathy**

A severe alpha-thalassaemia syndrome caused by deletion or inactivation of all four alpha-globin genes, producing haemoglobin Bart's (gamma<sub>4</sub>); it usually causes hydrops fetalis and is commonly fatal before or shortly after birth.

### **Basal**

Basal means at the base, lowest level, or resting state, such as basal metabolism, basal cells, or basal body temperature.

### **Basal Body**

A microtubule-organizing structure at the base of a cilium or flagellum, derived from a centriole, that anchors the cilium and initiates its axoneme.

### **Basal Cell**

Basal cell denotes basal cell, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Basal Lamina**

The basal lamina is a thin extracellular-matrix layer supporting epithelial cells and separating them from underlying connective tissue.

### **Basal Tear**

A basal tear is a tear occurring at the base of a structure; in the eye, a basal tear layer helps lubricate and protect the ocular surface.

### **Base Pair**

Two complementary nucleobases joined by hydrogen bonds in nucleic acids: adenine pairs with thymine (or uracil in RNA), and cytosine pairs with guanine.

### **Base Pairing**

The specific hydrogen-bonded association of complementary nucleobases that stabilizes nucleic-acid structure and permits accurate DNA replication,

transcription, and RNA hybridization.

### **Base Sequence**

The ordered sequence of nucleotides in a DNA or RNA molecule; it encodes genetic information and can be analysed to identify variants, pathogens, or inherited disorders.

### **Baseline**

A reference measurement or clinical state obtained before an intervention, illness, or period of observation, used for comparison with subsequent findings.

### **Basic Fuchsin**

Basic fuchsin is a magenta laboratory dye used in stains and microbiology, including methods for detecting selected bacteria.

### **Basic Research**

Basic research is used in relation to basic research during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Basidiomycota**

Basidiomycota is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Basilar Membrane**

Basilar membrane denotes basilar membrane, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Basiliximab**

Basiliximab is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Basis Pontis**

The basis pontis is the front portion of the pons containing descending motor fibers and pontine nuclei that relay signals to the cerebellum.

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### **Basophil Adenoma**

A basophil adenoma is a usually benign pituitary tumor composed of basophilic hormone-producing cells and may cause hormone excess or pressure symptoms.

### **Basophilic Focus**

A basophilic focus is an area that stains blue or purple with basic dyes, reflecting particular cellular or tissue components.

### **Basosquamous Carcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting basosquamous carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Batabulin**

Batabulin is an investigational vascular-disrupting antineoplastic agent studied for effects on tumor blood vessels and cancer growth.

### **Batimastat**

Batimastat is an investigational matrix-metalloproteinase inhibitor studied to limit tumor invasion and tissue breakdown.

### **Batrachotoxin**

A highly potent steroidal alkaloid toxin found in some poison frogs and birds that persistently activates voltage-gated sodium channels, causing neuronal and cardiac depolarization, arrhythmias, paralysis, and potentially death.

### **Batracylin**

Batracylin is an investigational anticancer compound studied for DNA damage and topoisomerase-related cytotoxic effects.

### **Batroxobin**

Batroxobin is a snake-venom-derived thrombin-like enzyme that converts fibrinogen to fibrin and has been studied or used in selected clotting and bleeding settings.

### **Batley Bacillus**

Batley bacillus is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bax Protein**

Bax protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **B-Cell Activation**

B-cell activation denotes b-cell activation, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bcgosis**

BCGosis is infection or disseminated disease caused by Bacille Calmette–Guérin organisms, usually after intravesical BCG treatment or in immune deficiency.

### **Beacopp Regimen**

Beacopp regimen is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Beat Number**

Beat number is the count of heartbeats or other rhythmic events over a specified interval and helps describe rate or rhythm.

### **Becaplermin**

Becaplermin is a recombinant platelet-derived growth factor gel used in selected diabetic foot ulcers with appropriate wound care.

### **Becatecarin**

Becatecarin is an investigational topoisomerase-I inhibitor studied for anticancer activity.

### **Beclomethasone**

Beclomethasone is a corticosteroid used by inhalation, nasal spray, or topical routes to reduce inflam-

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mation in asthma, rhinitis, or skin disease.

### **Becquerel**

A becquerel is the SI unit of radioactivity equal to one nuclear decay per second.

### **Bed Rest**

Bed rest is used in relation to bed rest during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Behavior**

Behavior is used in relation to behavior during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Behavior Disorder**

A clinical disorder or finding related to behavior disorder; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Behavior Test**

Behavior test is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Behavior Therapy**

Behavior therapy is used in relation to behavior therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Behavioral Abnormality**

Behavioral abnormality is used in relation to behavioral abnormality during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Behavioral Genetics**

Behavioral genetics is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Behavioral Medicine**

Behavioral medicine is used in relation to behavioral medicine during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Behenic Acid**

Behenic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Behr Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to behr syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Belinostat**

Belinostat is a histone-deacetylase inhibitor used for selected relapsed or refractory peripheral T-cell lymphomas.

### **Belotecan Hydrochloride**

Belotecan hydrochloride is an investigational topoisomerase-I inhibitor studied as an anticancer drug.

### **Benchmarking**

Benchmarking compares performance, outcomes, quality, or processes with a reference standard or peer group to identify improvement opportunities.

### **Bendamustine**

Bendamustine is an alkylating antineoplastic drug used for selected lymphoid cancers and chronic lymphocytic leukemia, with marrow and infection risks.

### **Bendamustine Hydrochloride**

Bendamustine hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt formulation of the alkylating antineoplastic drug bendamustine.

### **Bendiocarb**

Bendiocarb is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause cholinergic poisoning after exposure.



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### **Bendroflumethiazide**

Bendroflumethiazide is a thiazide diuretic used for hypertension or fluid retention and can lower blood pressure, potassium, and sodium.

### **Benfuracarb**

Benfuracarb is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Benign Ameloblastoma**

A neoplastic process affecting benign ameloblastoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Benign Epithelioma**

A benign epithelioma is a noncancerous epithelial tumor or growth that does not invade or metastasize but may require removal if symptomatic or uncertain.

### **Benign Hemangiopericytoma**

A benign hemangiopericytoma is a usually nonmalignant tumor around small blood vessels; modern classification often groups related lesions as solitary fibrous tumors.

### **Benign Meningioma**

A benign meningioma is a usually slow-growing tumor arising from the membranes around the brain and spinal cord and may cause symptoms by compression.

### **Benign Mesenchymoma**

A benign mesenchymoma is a rare noncancerous tumor containing more than one type of mesenchymal tissue, such as fat, cartilage, or bone.

### **Benign Myoepithelioma**

A benign myoepithelioma is a noncancerous tumor of myoepithelial cells, commonly arising in a salivary gland or other glandular tissue.

### **Benign Paraganglioma**

A benign paraganglioma is a usually slow-growing

neuroendocrine tumor arising from paraganglion cells and may secrete catecholamines or compress nearby structures.

### **Benign Prostate Hyperplasia**

A biomedical term referring to benign prostate hyperplasia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Benzaldehyde**

An aromatic aldehyde used mainly as a flavouring, fragrance, and chemical intermediate; concentrated exposure may irritate the eyes, skin, and respiratory tract and it is not a routine therapeutic medicine.

### **Benzazepines**

A family of chemical compounds containing a benzene ring fused to a seven-membered azepine ring; some derivatives have pharmacological activity, but the clinical effects depend on the individual compound.

### **Benzoates**

Salts or esters of benzoic acid, used as preservatives and, in selected preparations, as pharmaceutical excipients or metabolic agents; their safety depends on the specific compound and exposure.

### **Benzocaine**

Benzocaine is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Benzopyran**

A fused benzene-pyran chemical ring system found in several natural products and drug classes; it is a structural chemical term rather than one specific medicine.

### **Benzopyrene**

A polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbon formed during incomplete combustion and present in tobacco smoke and some charred foods; benzo[a]pyrene is

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mutagenic and carcinogenic after metabolic activation.

### **Benzopyrenes**

Polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons containing a benzopyrene structure, produced by incomplete combustion; several are environmental carcinogens and may damage DNA after metabolic activation.

### **Benzoyl Peroxide**

Benzoyl peroxide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in benzoyl peroxide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Benzoylphenylurea**

A class of insecticides that disrupt chitin formation in developing insects; these compounds are used for pest control rather than as human medicines.

### **Benzphetamine**

A sympathomimetic amine and stimulant formerly used in some countries as a short-term adjunct for weight reduction; it can cause dependence, cardiovascular effects, and insomnia and is restricted or unavailable in many jurisdictions.

### **Benztropine**

An antimuscarinic medicine used mainly to reduce drug-induced parkinsonism and acute dystonia; adverse effects include dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, confusion, and worsening of glaucoma.

### **Benzydamine**

A topical non-steroidal anti-inflammatory analgesic used for painful inflammation of the mouth, throat, or skin; local irritation, numbness, or allergic reactions may occur.

### **Benzylamines**

Organic compounds containing a benzyl group attached to an amino group; some derivatives are pharmacologically active, while others are chemical intermediates or industrial compounds.

### **BEP Regimen**

BEP regimen is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Berberine**

Berberine is a plant alkaloid sold in supplements and studied for metabolic and antimicrobial effects; interactions and adverse effects are possible.

### **Bergeyella**

Bergeyella is a genus of Gram-negative bacteria found in animals and the environment; human infection is uncommon and depends on the clinical isolate.

### **Bergeyella Zoohelcum**

Bergeyella zoohelcum is an uncommon zoonotic Gram-negative bacterium reported after animal exposure, especially in people with underlying illness.

### **Beryllium**

Beryllium is a metal whose dust or fumes can cause sensitization, chronic granulomatous lung disease, and cancer risk after occupational exposure.

### **Best Practice**

Best practice is used in relation to best practice during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Beta 2-Microglobulin**

A small protein associated with the class I major histocompatibility complex on nucleated cells; its blood or urine concentration may rise with inflammation, lymphoproliferative disease, or impaired renal handling.

### **Beta Globulin**

A group of serum proteins that migrate in the beta region during protein electrophoresis, including transferrin, complement proteins, and some lipoproteins; abnormal levels can reflect inflammation, liver disease, or plasma-cell disorders.

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### **Beta Particle**

A high-energy electron or positron emitted during radioactive beta decay; beta radiation can damage tissue and is used in selected medical imaging and radiotherapy applications.

### **Beta Radiation**

Ionizing radiation consisting of high-energy electrons or positrons emitted by unstable nuclei; it has moderate tissue penetration and can cause radiation injury or be used therapeutically.

### **Beta Tocopherol**

One of the naturally occurring forms of vitamin E, a lipid-soluble antioxidant; it is less biologically active than alpha-tocopherol in humans.

### **Beta-Chemokines**

A group of chemokines, generally in the CC family, that attract monocytes, lymphocytes, eosinophils, and other leukocytes through specific chemokine receptors during immune and inflammatory responses.

### **Betacoronavirus**

Betacoronavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Beta-Endorphin**

An endogenous opioid peptide derived from proopiomelanocortin in the pituitary and hypothalamus; it binds opioid receptors and contributes to modulation of pain, stress, and neuroendocrine function.

### **Beta-Glucans**

Polysaccharides made of glucose units linked by beta bonds, found in cereals, fungi, and yeast; their physiological effects vary by structure and may include effects on fibre intake and innate immune signalling.

### **Betaherpesvirinae**

Betaherpesvirinae is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific

product and patient.

### **Betaine**

A naturally occurring zwitterionic compound that acts as a methyl-group donor in homocysteine metabolism and helps maintain cellular osmotic balance; inherited defects in its pathway can cause homocystinuria.

### **Beta-Lactamase**

A bacterial enzyme that hydrolyses the beta-lactam ring of susceptible penicillins, cephalosporins, or related antibiotics, producing antimicrobial resistance; inhibitors may restore activity against selected organisms.

### **Beta-Mannosidosis**

Beta-mannosidosis is an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by beta-mannosidase deficiency and can produce developmental, hearing, immune, or skeletal problems.

### **Betamethasone**

A potent synthetic glucocorticoid used topically or systemically to suppress inflammation and immune responses; prolonged or extensive use can cause skin atrophy, infection, adrenal suppression, and other corticosteroid effects.

### **Betamethasone Valerate**

A topical corticosteroid ester used for inflammatory skin disorders such as eczema and psoriasis; prolonged, occlusive, or extensive application increases the risk of local skin atrophy and systemic corticosteroid absorption.

### **Betaretrovirus**

Betaretrovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Beta-Sheet**

A protein secondary structure formed by extended polypeptide strands stabilized by hydrogen bonds;

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abnormal beta-sheet-rich aggregates occur in disorders such as amyloidosis and some neurodegenerative diseases.

### **Betaxolol**

Betaxolol is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Betazole**

Betazole is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Bevacizumab**

Bevacizumab is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Bexarotene**

An oral retinoid X-receptor agonist used mainly for cutaneous T-cell lymphoma; it commonly causes hypertriglyceridaemia, hypothyroidism, and liver abnormalities and is teratogenic.

### **Bezafibrate**

Bezafibrate is a fibrate lipid-lowering drug that activates PPAR-alpha and lowers triglycerides; muscle and liver effects require monitoring.

### **Bibliotherapy**

Bibliotherapy is used in relation to bibliotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Bicalutamide**

A non-steroidal androgen-receptor antagonist used in prostate cancer, usually with androgen-deprivation therapy; adverse effects include hot flashes, breast enlargement, sexual dysfunction, and possible liver injury.

### **Bicuculline**

Bicuculline is a research compound that blocks GABA-A receptors and can provoke seizures in experimental systems.

### **Bicuspid**

Bicuspid means having two cusps, as in a bicuspid aortic valve or a premolar tooth with two main points.

### **Bid Protein**

Bid protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Bifidobacterium**

Bifidobacterium is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bifidobacterium Adolescentis**

Bifidobacterium adolescentis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bifidobacterium Animalis**

Bifidobacterium animalis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bifidobacterium Bifidum**

Bifidobacterium bifidum is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bifidobacterium Breve**

Bifidobacterium breve is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

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### **Bifidobacterium Dentium**

Bifidobacterium dentium is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Bifidobacterium Longum**

Bifidobacterium longum is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Biglycan**

Biglycan is a small proteoglycan of the extracellular matrix involved in collagen organization, inflammation, and tissue repair.

### **Bilateral**

Bilateral means affecting or involving both sides of the body or a paired structure.

### **Bilateral Microphthalmos**

Bilateral microphthalmos is abnormally small size of both eyes, a congenital condition that can impair vision and occur with other developmental abnormalities.

### **Bilateral Oophorectomy**

Bilateral oophorectomy is used in relation to bilateral oophorectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Bile Pigment**

A pigment derived largely from haem breakdown, chiefly bilirubin, that is processed by the liver and excreted in bile; accumulation in blood and tissues causes jaundice.

### **Biliary**

Biliary means relating to bile, the gallbladder, or bile ducts that transport bile from the liver to the intestine.

### **Biliary Calculi**

Biliary calculi are gallstones or stones in the biliary

tract formed from crystallized bile components and capable of causing pain, obstruction, or inflammation.

### **Biliary Fistula**

A biliary fistula is an abnormal connection allowing bile to leak from the biliary system into another organ, the abdomen, or the skin.

### **Bilophila**

Bilophila is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bilophila Wadsworthia**

Bilophila wadsworthia is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bimatoprost**

Bimatoprost is a prostaglandin analogue used as eye drops to lower intraocular pressure and, in some formulations, promote eyelash growth.

### **Binder Excipient**

A binder excipient is an inactive pharmaceutical ingredient that helps powder particles adhere during tablet formation.

### **Binding Protein**

Binding protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Binding Site**

A specific region of a receptor, enzyme, antibody, nucleic acid, or other molecule to which another molecule binds through chemical and physical interactions, influencing biological activity or measurement.

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## **Binswanger Disease**

A clinical disorder or finding related to binswanger disease; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## **Bioaccumulation**

Bioaccumulation is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

## **Bioassay**

Bioassay is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## **Biochemical Reaction**

Biochemical reaction is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

## **Bioengineering**

The application of engineering principles to biology and medicine, including the design of medical devices, biomaterials, tissue-engineering systems, prostheses, and diagnostic technologies.

## **Bio-Informatics**

The use of computational methods to store, analyse, and interpret biological data such as DNA sequences, gene expression, protein structures, and clinical genomic information.

## **Biological**

Relating to living organisms, their structures, functions, processes, or products; in medicine, a biological product is a therapeutic or diagnostic substance made from or resembling a biological source.

## **Biological Availability**

Biological availability is a pharmacologic, physio-

logic, or clinical-care concept used to describe a measurable effect, intervention, or patient-management issue.

## **Biological Clock**

An internal timing system that coordinates recurring biological rhythms, especially the circadian rhythm, through networks involving the suprachiasmatic nucleus, hormones, and environmental cues.

## **Biological Model**

A cell, tissue, organism, computational system, or other representation used to study biological mechanisms, disease, or treatment responses.

## **Biological Process**

A coordinated series of molecular, cellular, or physiological events in a living organism, such as metabolism, cell division, inflammation, or tissue repair.

## **Biological Relative**

A person related by shared genetic ancestry, in contrast to a relative related solely by marriage or legal adoption; family history uses this distinction when assessing inherited risk.

## **Biological Therapy**

Biological therapy is used in relation to biological therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Biological Transport**

The movement of ions, molecules, cells, or fluids within or across biological membranes and tissues, by processes such as diffusion, filtration, channels, pumps, and vesicular transport.

## **Bioluminescence**

Light produced by a living organism through a chemical reaction, commonly involving luciferin and luciferase; it is used in biological research and diagnostic assays.



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## **Biomaterial**

A natural or synthetic material designed to interact with a biological system, for example in implants, prostheses, drug delivery, wound dressings, or tissue engineering.

## **Biomechanical Compliance**

The change in volume or displacement produced by a given change in pressure or force in a biological structure; examples include lung, vascular, and joint compliance.

## **Biomedical Cement**

Biomedical cement is a material used to fill, stabilize, anchor, or repair bone or other tissues in medical procedures.

## **Biomedical Research**

Biomedical research is used in relation to biomedical research during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Biomedical Tape**

Biomedical tape is adhesive material used to secure dressings, devices, sensors, or skin edges; its adhesive and backing determine skin tolerance.

## **Biomedicine**

Medicine grounded in the biological sciences, including the study of disease mechanisms, diagnosis, prevention, and treatment through laboratory and clinical research.

## **Biometry**

Biometry is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## **Biomimetics**

The design of materials, devices, or processes that imitate biological structures or functions, such as tissue-like scaffolds or gecko-inspired adhesives.

## **Biomphalaria**

A genus of freshwater snails that serves as an intermediate host for *Schistosoma mansoni*, the parasite causing intestinal schistosomiasis in humans.

## **Biopolymer**

A polymer produced by living organisms, such as proteins, nucleic acids, polysaccharides, and natural polyesters; biopolymers provide biological structure and function and are also used in biomaterials.

## **Biopsy Lung**

Biopsy lung is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## **Biopsy Site**

Biopsy site is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## **Biopsy Specimen**

Biopsy specimen is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## **Bioreactor**

A controlled vessel or system in which cells, tissues, microorganisms, or enzymes are cultured or used to produce biological materials, medicines, or engineered tissues.

## **Biospecimen**

Biospecimen is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

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## **Biotechnology**

The use of living cells, organisms, or biological molecules to develop products and processes, including vaccines, recombinant medicines, molecular diagnostics, and gene therapies.

## **Biotin**

A water-soluble B vitamin that acts as a cofactor for carboxylase enzymes involved in fatty-acid synthesis, gluconeogenesis, and amino-acid metabolism; deficiency is uncommon but can cause dermatitis, alopecia, and neurological symptoms.

## **Biotinylation**

Biotinylation is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

## **Bipartite Ossification**

Bipartite ossification is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## **Biphenyl Compounds**

Chemicals containing two benzene rings joined by a single bond; some polychlorinated biphenyls are persistent environmental pollutants associated with toxic, endocrine, immune, and carcinogenic effects.

## **Bipolar Neuron**

A bipolar neuron has one dendrite and one axon extending from opposite sides of its cell body, as found in the retina and sensory pathways.

## **Bipolaris**

A biomedical term referring to bipolaris; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## **Birth**

Birth is delivery of a fetus from the uterus, involving labor, delivery of the infant, and separation or delivery of the placenta.

## **Birth Injury**

A clinical disorder or finding related to birth injury; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## **Birth Order**

Birth order is used in relation to birth order during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Birth Weight**

Birth weight is used in relation to birth weight during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Bisacodyl**

Bisacodyl is a stimulant laxative that increases bowel movement and is used for short-term constipation or bowel preparation.

## **Bisbenzimidazole**

Bisbenzimidazole is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Bisexuality**

Bisexuality is a sexual orientation involving attraction to more than one gender; it is not a disease or disorder.

## **Bismuth**

Bismuth is a metal used in some medicines and industrial products; excessive exposure or certain compounds can cause toxicity.

## **Bisoprolol**

Bisoprolol is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Bizelesin**

Bizelesin is an investigational DNA-alkylating anti-neoplastic compound studied for cytotoxic effects.

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## **BK Virus**

BK virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## **Bladder Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting bladder neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Bladder Pain**

Pain perceived in the lower abdomen, pelvis, or bladder region, often related to urinary infection, bladder pain syndrome, stones, inflammation, or malignancy; assessment depends on urinary and systemic symptoms.

## **Blast Cell**

Blast cell denotes blast cell, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## **Blast Phase**

Blast phase is an advanced stage of a myeloproliferative blood cancer marked by a high proportion of immature blast cells and aggressive disease.

## **Blastocystis**

A biomedical term referring to blastocystis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## **Blautia Producta**

Blautia producta is an anaerobic bacterium found in the human gut; its clinical significance depends on the specimen and compatible illness.

## **Bleeding Tendency**

Bleeding tendency is used in relation to bleeding tendency during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Bleeding Time**

Bleeding time is used in relation to bleeding time during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Bleomycin**

Bleomycin is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Bleomycin Sulfate**

Bleomycin sulfate is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Blepharophimosis**

Blepharophimosis is abnormally short horizontal eyelid openings, often with drooping lids and other features in blepharophimosis-ptosis syndromes.

## **Blepharoptosis**

Blepharoptosis is drooping of the upper eyelid caused by muscle, nerve, tendon, congenital, aging, or mechanical problems.

## **Blinded**

Blinded describes a research participant, clinician, or assessor who does not know the assigned treatment or relevant result, reducing expectation bias.

## **Bloating**

Bloating is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

## **Blocking Antibody**

An antibody that prevents a ligand from binding to its receptor or interferes with a biological interaction; blocking antibodies can be therapeutic, protective, or involved in autoimmune disease.

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## Blood

A fluid connective tissue consisting of plasma, red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets; it transports gases, nutrients, hormones, and waste and participates in immunity, coagulation, and temperature regulation.

## Blood Bank

A service that collects, tests, processes, stores, and distributes blood and blood components for transfusion, with compatibility testing and safeguards against infection and transfusion reactions.

## Blood Cell

Blood cell denotes blood cell, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Blood Circulation

The continuous movement of blood through the pulmonary and systemic vascular circuits, driven by the heart, to deliver oxygen and nutrients and remove carbon dioxide and metabolic waste.

## Blood Glucose

The concentration of glucose in blood, maintained by dietary absorption, hepatic production, insulin, and counter-regulatory hormones; abnormal levels indicate hypoglycaemia or hyperglycaemia.

## Blood Preservation

The collection, anticoagulation, processing, refrigeration, freezing, and quality control used to maintain donated blood or blood components until transfusion.

## Blood Product

A therapeutic component prepared from donated blood, such as red-cell concentrates, platelets, plasma, or cryoprecipitate, selected according to the patient's clinical need.

## Blood Protein

Blood protein is a protein or protein-related

molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## Blood Sedimentation

The settling of red blood cells in anticoagulated blood; the erythrocyte sedimentation rate is a non-specific marker that may increase with inflammation, infection, anaemia, or other conditions.

## Blood Substitutes

Fluids or artificial products intended to restore circulating volume or, in some cases, oxygen-carrying capacity when donated blood is unavailable or unsuitable; most currently used substitutes provide volume rather than durable oxygen transport.

## Blood Treatment

The diagnosis-specific use of medicines, transfusion, apheresis, replacement factors, or other interventions to treat disorders of blood cells, coagulation, plasma proteins, or blood-borne infection.

## Blood Vessel

Blood vessel denotes blood vessel, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Blood Volume

The total amount of blood in the circulation, comprising plasma and cellular components; it varies with body size and fluid balance, and abnormal reductions or increases contribute to shock or circulatory strain.

## Blue Nevus

A blue nevus is a usually benign blue-gray skin mole caused by pigment cells located deeper in the dermis.

## Blunted Affect

Blunted affect is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends

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on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Blurred Vision**

Blurred vision is used in relation to blurred vision during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **B-Lymphocyte**

A B lymphocyte is an immune cell that can mature into an antibody-producing plasma cell or a memory B cell.

### **Bocavirus**

Bocavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Bodily Secretion**

Bodily secretion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Body Cavity**

A fluid-containing space within the body that houses and protects organs, including the cranial, vertebral, thoracic, abdominal, and pelvic cavities.

### **Body Composition**

The proportions of fat, lean tissue, bone mineral, and body water in the body; it is assessed in nutrition, obesity, sports medicine, and some chronic diseases.

### **Body Fluid**

Water and dissolved substances in intracellular or extracellular compartments, including plasma, interstitial fluid, cerebrospinal fluid, and lymph; abnormal volume or composition causes fluid and electrolyte disorders.

### **Body Height**

The vertical measurement from the soles of the

feet to the top of the head; it is used to assess growth, nutrition, body-mass index, and medication or physiological calculations.

### **Body Image**

A person's perception, thoughts, and feelings about their own body and appearance; severe disturbance may occur in body dysmorphic disorder or eating disorders.

### **Body Odor**

Odour produced when skin secretions, especially sweat, are metabolized by microorganisms; a new or unusual odour may occasionally reflect infection, metabolic disease, or medication.

### **Body Piercing**

The intentional creation of a skin or mucosal opening to insert jewellery; complications include bleeding, infection, scarring, allergic reaction, and damage to teeth or cartilage.

### **Body Position**

The arrangement and orientation of the body or its parts, such as standing, supine, prone, or lateral positions; position affects examination findings, ventilation, circulation, and procedures.

### **Body Region**

A named anatomical area used to locate structures, symptoms, injuries, or examination findings, such as the chest, abdomen, pelvis, or upper limb.

### **Body Space**

An anatomical compartment or potential space within the body, such as the pleural, peritoneal, or retroperitoneal space, where fluid, air, blood, or infection may accumulate.

### **Body Substance**

Any material originating from or present in the body, including blood, saliva, urine, faeces, respiratory secretions, and tissue; handling may require infection-control precautions.

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## Body Surface

The external area of the skin and accessible mucous membranes; body-surface area is also estimated clinically for burns, drug dosing, and physiological calculations.

## Body Wall

The layers of muscle, fascia, connective tissue, bone, and skin that enclose a body compartment, such as the thoracic or abdominal wall.

## Body Weight

The measured mass of a person, influenced by fat, muscle, bone, water, and organs; it is used with height and clinical context to assess growth, nutrition, fluid balance, and medication dosing.

## Bohring Syndrome

A clinical disorder or finding related to bohring syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## Bolt Device

Bolt device is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

## Bolus Infusion

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to bolus infusion; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Bombesin

Bombesin is a peptide signaling molecule related to gastrointestinal and neurologic hormones and used in research on digestion, appetite, and tumors.

## Bombesin Receptor

Bombesin receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## Bone Callus

Bone callus denotes bone callus, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Bone Cement

Bone cement denotes bone cement, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Bone Cyst

Bone cyst denotes bone cyst, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Bone Development

Bone development denotes bone development, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Bone Disease

A clinical disorder or finding related to bone disease; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## Bone Marrow Disorder

A clinical disorder or finding related to bone marrow disorder; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## Bone Marrow Transplantation

Bone marrow transplantation denotes bone marrow transplantation, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Bone Matrix

Bone matrix denotes bone matrix, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, inner-



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vation, and function.

### **Bone Necrosis**

Bone necrosis denotes bone necrosis, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting bone neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Bone Pain**

Bone pain denotes bone pain, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Plate**

Bone plate denotes bone plate, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Regeneration**

Bone regeneration denotes bone regeneration, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Remodeling**

Bone remodeling denotes bone remodeling, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Resorption**

Bone resorption denotes bone resorption, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Screws**

Bone screws denotes bone screws, an anatomical

structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bone Transplantation**

Bone transplantation denotes bone transplantation, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bony Labyrinth**

The system of fluid-filled spaces within the petrous temporal bone that encloses the membranous labyrinth of the inner ear and contains the cochlea, vestibule, and semicircular canals.

### **Boranes**

Boranes are compounds of boron and hydrogen used in chemical synthesis and research; some are flammable or toxic.

### **Border Definition**

Border definition is used in relation to border definition during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Borderline**

Borderline is used in relation to borderline during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Bordetella**

Bordetella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bordetella Avium**

Bordetella avium is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bordetella Bronchiseptica**

Bordetella bronchiseptica is a bacterial taxon; dis-

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ease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bordetella Hinzii**

*Bordetella hinzii* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bordetella Parapertussis**

*Bordetella parapertussis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bordetella Petrii**

*Bordetella petrii* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Boric Acid**

A weak boron-containing compound used in some antiseptic, insecticidal, and industrial products; ingestion can be toxic.

### **Boron**

A chemical element present in food, water, and industrial materials; it has no established essential human biological role, and excessive exposure can cause gastrointestinal, skin, reproductive, or developmental toxicity.

### **Borrelia Infection**

*Borrelia* infection is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Borrelia Miyamotoi**

*Borrelia miyamotoi* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bortezomib**

A proteasome inhibitor used mainly to treat multiple myeloma and some lymphomas; important adverse effects include peripheral neuropathy, cytopenias, gastrointestinal symptoms, and herpes-zoster reactivation.

### **Bosentan**

Bosentan is an endothelin-receptor antagonist used for pulmonary arterial hypertension and requiring liver-function and pregnancy precautions.

### **Botany**

Botany is the scientific study of plants, including their structure, growth, physiology, classification, and uses.

### **Bottle Feeding**

Bottle feeding is used in relation to bottle feeding during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Botulinum Toxin**

A neurotoxin produced by *Clostridium botulinum* that blocks acetylcholine release at neuromuscular junctions; purified preparations are used for selected muscle spasticity, dystonias, migraine, sweating, and cosmetic indications, but excess exposure can cause paralysis and respiratory failure.

### **Bouin's Solution**

Bouin's solution is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Bovine Anaplasmosis**

Bovine anaplasmosis is a tick- or blood-transmitted infection of cattle caused by *Anaplasma marginale*, producing red-cell destruction and anemia.

### **Bovine Papillomavirus**

Bovine papillomavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of

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transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Bowel Burn**

Bowel burn is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Bowel Urgency**

A sudden, difficult-to-defer need to defecate, commonly associated with diarrhoea, inflammatory bowel disease, irritable bowel syndrome, infection, or rectal disorders.

### **Bowen's Disease**

A clinical disorder or finding related to bowen's disease; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Bowman Membrane**

Bowman membrane denotes bowman membrane, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Brachycephaly**

Brachycephaly is a broad, shortened skull shape that may be positional or caused by premature fusion of coronal sutures.

### **Brachydactyly**

Brachydactyly is congenital shortening of fingers or toes caused by abnormal development of the bones or surrounding tissues.

### **Bradykinin**

Bradykinin is a peptide mediator that increases blood-vessel permeability, dilates vessels, and contributes to pain and inflammation.

### **Brain Disorder**

A clinical disorder or finding related to brain disorder; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Brain Fornix**

A C-shaped fibre tract of the limbic system connecting the hippocampus with the mammillary bodies and septal region; it contributes to memory circuitry.

### **Brain Mapping**

Methods used to identify the anatomical or functional organization of the brain, including neuroimaging, electrophysiology, and cortical stimulation during selected neurosurgical procedures.

### **Brain Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting brain neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Brain Wave**

An oscillating pattern of electrical activity generated by populations of neurons and recorded by electroencephalography; frequency and amplitude vary with sleep, alertness, and neurological disease.

### **Branchioma**

A branchioma is a tumor or cyst arising from tissues related to embryonic branchial structures, often presenting in the neck.

### **Branchio-Oto-Renal Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to branchio-oto-renal syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Brassicasterol**

Brassicasterol is a plant sterol found especially in rapeseed and related oils and used as a marker of plant-oil composition.

### **Brassidic Acid**

Brassidic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

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## Breast

A paired mammary organ composed of glandular tissue, ducts, fat, connective tissue, and skin; it produces milk after pregnancy and is a site of benign and malignant disease.

## Breast Carcinoma

A neoplastic process affecting breast carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Breast Duct

A channel that carries milk from mammary lobules toward the nipple; ductal obstruction, inflammation, atypia, or carcinoma can produce a breast lump or nipple discharge.

## Breast Feed

To feed an infant with human milk directly from the breast; breastfeeding provides nutrition and immune factors, and may be affected by maternal or infant medical conditions and medicines.

## Breast Finding

Any abnormal or notable breast observation, such as a lump, pain, skin change, nipple inversion, or discharge; assessment may require examination and imaging or biopsy.

## Breast Lobe

A major subdivision of the mammary gland containing groups of lobules and ducts that converge toward the nipple.

## Breast Lobule

A functional unit of the mammary gland composed of milk-producing acini and their small ducts; lobules enlarge and differentiate during pregnancy and lactation.

## Breast Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting breast neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Breast Self-Examination

Inspection and palpation of one's own breasts to notice new lumps or changes; it may improve awareness but is not a substitute for recommended population screening or clinical assessment.

## Breath Test

Analysis of exhaled air to detect or measure a substance produced by the body or by intestinal microorganisms; examples include the urea breath test for *Helicobacter pylori* and hydrogen or methane testing for carbohydrate malabsorption and intestinal overgrowth.

## Brefeldin A

Brefeldin A is a fungal compound used experimentally to disrupt Golgi trafficking and intracellular protein transport.

## Bretylium Tosylate

Bretylium tosylate is an older antiarrhythmic drug that suppresses ventricular fibrillation and is now rarely used because of alternatives and adverse effects.

## Brevibacillus

Brevibacillus is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

## Brevibacterium

Brevibacterium is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Brevibacterium Casei

Brevibacterium casei is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Brevundimonas

A biomedical term referring to brevundimonas; its

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classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Brevundimonas Diminuta**

A biomedical term referring to *brevundimonas diminuta*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Brevundimonas Vesicularis**

A biomedical term referring to *brevundimonas vesicularis*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Brimonidine Tartrate**

Brimonidine tartrate is an alpha-2 adrenergic agonist used in eye drops to lower intraocular pressure and topically for some facial redness.

### **Brivanib**

Brivanib is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Brivanib Alaninate**

Brivanib alaninate is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Brivudine**

Brivudine is an antiviral drug used in some countries for herpes zoster; it has a dangerous interaction with fluoropyrimidine chemotherapy.

### **Broad Ligament**

Broad ligament denotes broad ligament, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bromelain**

A mixture of proteolytic enzymes derived from pineapple; it is marketed as a supplement and has been studied for inflammation and pain, but evidence and product standardization vary and interactions or allergy are possible.

### **Bromhexine**

A mucolytic medicine that reduces the viscosity of bronchial mucus and may help expectoration; gastrointestinal upset, rash, or rare serious skin reactions can occur.

### **Bromine**

A reactive halogen used in industrial chemicals and flame retardants; elemental bromine and many bromine compounds can irritate or burn tissues, and excessive exposure may cause systemic toxicity.

### **Bromobenzenes**

A group of aromatic compounds in which one or more bromine atoms are attached to benzene; they are mainly industrial chemicals and may cause irritation or toxic effects depending on the compound and exposure.

### **Bromocriptine**

An ergot-derived dopamine D2-receptor agonist used for hyperprolactinaemia and selected Parkinson disease or endocrine disorders; nausea, postural hypotension, hallucinations, and rare fibrotic complications may occur.

### **Bromodeoxyuridine**

A thymidine analogue incorporated into newly synthesized DNA during the S phase; it is used experimentally to measure cell proliferation and can interfere with DNA replication at high exposure.

### **Bromophos**

An organophosphorus insecticide; exposure can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and produce cholinergic poisoning, including sweating, salivation, bronchospasm, vomiting, weakness, and seizures.

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### **Bromouracil**

A thymine analogue used mainly in experimental mutagenesis research; its altered base pairing can introduce DNA replication errors.

### **Bromovirus**

Bromovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Bromthymol Blue**

A pH indicator that changes colour near neutrality and is used in laboratory demonstrations and some analytical tests; it is not a therapeutic medicine.

### **Bronchial**

Relating to the bronchi, the large airways branching from the trachea; bronchial disease may cause cough, wheeze, mucus production, or airflow obstruction.

### **Bronchial Fistula**

An abnormal connection involving a bronchus and another structure, such as the pleural space, oesophagus, or skin; it can cause persistent air leak, infection, coughing, or respiratory compromise.

### **Bronchial Hemorrhage**

Bleeding from bronchial vessels or airways, usually presenting as haemoptysis; severe bleeding can obstruct the airway or cause respiratory failure.

### **Bronchial Obstruction**

Partial or complete blockage of a bronchus by mucus, a foreign body, tumour, swelling, or external compression, causing impaired ventilation and sometimes distal collapse or infection.

### **Bronchial Stricture**

Abnormal narrowing of a bronchus, caused by scarring, inflammation, tumour, infection, or prior instrumentation, which may produce localized wheeze, cough, recurrent infection, or atelectasis.

### **Bronchoconstriction**

Narrowing of the bronchi due to contraction of airway smooth muscle, mucosal swelling, or mucus; it increases airway resistance and occurs in asthma, allergic reactions, and some irritant exposures.

### **Bronchoconstrictor Agents**

Substances that narrow the airways by contracting bronchial smooth muscle or causing airway inflammation, including histamine, leukotrienes, irritant gases, and some medicines.

### **Bronchogenic Carcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting bronchogenic carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Bronchomalacia**

Weakness and excessive collapsibility of the bronchial walls due to deficient cartilage or structural support; it may cause noisy breathing, cough, recurrent infections, or expiratory airway obstruction.

### **Bronchus Disease**

A clinical disorder or finding related to bronchus disease; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Bronchus Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting bronchus neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Brown Fat**

Adipose tissue rich in mitochondria that produces heat through uncoupled oxidative metabolism; it is prominent in infants and can be activated by cold exposure in adults.

### **Brucella**

Brucella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.



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### **Brucella Abortus**

*Brucella abortus* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Brucella Canis**

*Brucella canis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Brucella Melitensis**

*Brucella melitensis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Brucella Suis**

*Brucella suis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Brucellaceae**

Brucellaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Brunner Gland**

Brunner gland denotes brunner gland, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bryostatin**

Bryostatin is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Buccal Mucosa**

The moist mucous membrane lining the inside of the cheeks; it is examined for ulcers, infection, pig-

mentation, trauma, and oral cancer and can absorb some medicines.

### **Buccalmucosa**

A spelling variant of buccal mucosa, the moist lining of the inner cheeks.

### **Budesonide**

A corticosteroid used by inhalation for asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and by oral or rectal preparations for selected inflammatory bowel disorders; local and systemic corticosteroid adverse effects are possible.

### **Budvicia**

Budvicia is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Budvicia Aquatica**

Budvicia aquatica is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bufonidae**

Bufonidae is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Buformin**

Buformin is a former biguanide diabetes drug withdrawn or restricted because of lactic-acidosis risk.

### **Bulbourethral Glands**

Bulbourethral glands denotes bulbourethral glands, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Bulimia**

An eating-disorder symptom characterized by recurrent episodes of binge eating with a sense of

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loss of control; in bulimia nervosa, episodes are followed by recurrent compensatory behaviours such as vomiting, fasting, or excessive exercise.

## **Bulla**

A bulla is a large fluid-filled blister or a hollow air-filled structure, depending on the clinical context.

## **Bully**

Bullying is repeated harmful aggression or intimidation involving a power imbalance and can cause injury, anxiety, depression, and other health effects.

## **Bungarotoxins**

Neurotoxins from kraits (*Bungarus* species) that bind or interfere with nicotinic acetylcholine receptors at the neuromuscular junction; envenomation can cause progressive paralysis and respiratory failure.

## **Bunyaviridae**

Bunyaviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## **Bupivacaine**

Bupivacaine is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Bupivacaine Hydrochloride**

Bupivacaine hydrochloride is a medication or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

## **Buprenorphine**

Buprenorphine is a partial opioid agonist used for opioid-use disorder and pain; it can cause dependence but has a ceiling effect on respiratory depression.

## **Bupropion**

Bupropion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## **Burkholderia**

Burkholderia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Burkholderia Cenocepacia**

Burkholderia cenocepacia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Burkholderia Cepacia**

Burkholderia cepacia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Burkholderia Gladioli**

Burkholderia gladioli is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Burkholderia Mallei**

Burkholderia mallei is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Burkholderia Pseudomallei**

Burkholderia pseudomallei is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

## **Burkholderiaceae**

Burkholderiaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, speci-

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men source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Bursa Of Fabricius**

The bursa of Fabricius is a lymphoid organ in birds where B lymphocytes mature; it has no direct human counterpart.

### **Buruli Ulcer**

Buruli ulcer is a destructive skin infection caused by *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, producing painless nodules or ulcers that can damage tissue and joints.

### **Buserelin**

Buserelin is a gonadotropin-releasing hormone analogue that suppresses reproductive hormones after an initial stimulation phase and is used in selected fertility or hormone-sensitive conditions.

### **Buspirone**

Buspirone is a nonbenzodiazepine anxiolytic used mainly for generalized anxiety and does not provide immediate relief like sedative medicines.

### **Busulfan**

An alkylating chemotherapy medicine used chiefly as conditioning before haematopoietic stem-cell transplantation and, less commonly, for chronic myeloid leukaemia; it can cause prolonged myelosuppression, seizures, infertility, pulmonary injury, and hepatic veno-occlusive disease.

### **Butanol**

Butanol is a flammable alcohol solvent; ingestion or substantial exposure can irritate tissues and depress the central nervous system.

### **Buthionine Sulfoximine**

Buthionine sulfoximine is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Butocarboxim**

Butocarboxim is a carbamate insecticide that can

inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Buttiauxella**

*Buttiauxella* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Buttiauxella Agrestis**

A biomedical term referring to *buttiauxella agrestis*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Buttiauxella Ferragutiae**

A biomedical term referring to *buttiauxella ferragutiae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Buttiauxella Gaviniae**

A biomedical term referring to *buttiauxella gaviniae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Buttiauxella Noackiae**

A biomedical term referring to *buttiauxella noackiae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Buttocks**

The paired fleshy regions overlying the gluteal muscles at the back of the pelvis, formed mainly by muscle and subcutaneous fat.

### **Bent Penis**

Curvature of the penis that may be congenital or acquired, often from Peyronie disease; it can cause pain or difficulty with sexual intercourse.

### **Bleeding During Pregnancy**

Vaginal bleeding during pregnancy; its significance

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varies with gestational age and amount. Urgent evaluation is needed for heavy bleeding, pain, dizziness, or bleeding later in pregnancy.

### **Blood Clots**

Clumps of blood formed during clotting; abnormal clots can obstruct veins or arteries and cause deep vein thrombosis, pulmonary embolism, stroke, or other ischemia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Clot Blood (Blood Clots)

### **Brain Lesions**

Areas of abnormal brain tissue caused by tumors, stroke, infection, inflammation, trauma, demyelination, or vascular disease; symptoms depend on the lesion's location and size.

### **Breast Calcifications**

Small calcium deposits in breast tissue seen on mammography; they are often benign, but some patterns require additional imaging or biopsy.

### **Breast Lumps**

Localized breast swelling or a mass; causes include cysts, fibroadenoma, infection, trauma, or cancer. Persistent or new lumps need clinical evaluation.

### **Breast Rash**

A rash affecting breast skin; causes include dermatitis, infection, irritation, or, less commonly, inflammatory breast cancer. Persistent one-sided changes require evaluation.

### **Burning Feet**

Burning, tingling, or painful sensations in the feet, commonly related to peripheral neuropathy, diabetes, nutritional deficiency, alcohol, medicines, or nerve compression.

### **Bardet-Biedl Syndrome (BBS)**

A rare inherited disorder that may cause retinal degeneration, obesity, extra fingers or toes, kidney disease, and developmental or reproductive problems.

#### **Synonyms:**

BBS

### **Bedbugs**

Small blood-feeding insects that cause itchy bites and skin reactions and can spread through bedding, clothing, and furniture.

### **Bedsore (Pressure Ulcers)**

Injuries to skin and underlying tissue caused by prolonged pressure, usually over bony areas in people with limited mobility.

### **Bee Sting**

A skin injury caused by a bee's stinger that may cause local pain and swelling or, in allergic people, a serious systemic reaction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stings, Bee

### **Benign Brain Tumor**

A noncancerous growth in or around the brain that can still cause symptoms by pressing on brain tissue, nerves, or fluid pathways.

### **Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo (BPPV)**

Brief episodes of spinning dizziness triggered by changes in head position, usually caused by displaced inner-ear crystals.

### **Benign Peripheral Nerve Tumor**

A noncancerous tumor arising from or near a peripheral nerve, potentially causing a lump, pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness.

### **Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia (BPH)**

Noncancerous enlargement of the prostate that can obstruct urine flow and cause urinary frequency, urgency, weak stream, or incomplete emptying.

#### **Synonyms:**

Prostate Gland Enlargement

### **Bladder Stones**

Hard mineral deposits that form in the bladder and

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may cause painful urination, blood in urine, urinary frequency, or difficulty emptying the bladder.

**Synonyms:**

Bladder Calculi

**Blood In Urine (Hematuria)**

Visible or microscopic blood in the urine, which may result from infection, stones, injury, kidney disease, medicines, or urinary tract cancer.

**Synonyms:**

Microscopic Hematuria

**Brain AVM (Arteriovenous Malformation)**

An abnormal tangle of brain arteries and veins that can disrupt blood flow and may bleed or cause seizures, headaches, or neurologic deficits.

**Synonyms:**

Brain Arteriovenous Malformation

**Breast Cysts**

Fluid-filled sacs within breast tissue that may be tender or palpable and are usually benign.

**Broken Collarbone**

A fracture of the clavicle, usually caused by a fall, direct impact, or contact injury and associated with shoulder pain and reduced arm movement.

**Synonyms:**

Broken Clavicle

**Broken Hand**

A fracture of one or more bones of the hand, causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or impaired movement.

**Broken Leg**

A fracture of one or more bones in the leg, commonly causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or inability to bear weight.

**Synonyms:**

Leg Fracture

**Broken Nose**

A fracture of one or more nasal bones that may

cause pain, swelling, bleeding, deformity, or difficulty breathing through the nose.

**Broken Ribs**

Fractures of one or more ribs, usually causing localized chest pain that worsens with breathing, coughing, or movement.

**Broken Wrist**

A fracture involving one or more bones near the wrist, often causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or reduced hand function.

**Bunions**

A bony prominence and deformity at the base of the big toe caused by shifting of the joint, often producing pain and footwear difficulty.

**Burns**

Tissue injuries caused by heat, chemicals, electricity, radiation, or friction, with severity determined by depth, size, and location.

**Synonyms:**

Burn Injury Burns First Aid (Burns)

**BANF**

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

**Barber's Itch**

Alternate index label; see *Folliculitis*.

**Barlow's Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Mitral valve prolapse*.

**Barotitis Media**

Alternate index label; see *Airplane ear*.

**Basal Joint Arthritis**

Alternate index label; see *Thumb arthritis*.

**BBS**

Alternate index label; see *Bardet-Biedl syndrome (BBS)*.

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## **BDD**

Alternate index label; see *Body dysmorphic disorder*.

## **Benign Migratory Glossitis**

Alternate index label; see *Geographic tongue*.

## **Berger's Disease**

Alternate index label; see *IgA nephropathy (Berger disease)*.

## **Bilateral Acoustic Neurofibromatosis**

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

## **Bladder Calculi**

Alternate index label; see *Bladder stones*.

## **Bladder Control, Loss Of**

Alternate index label; see *Urinary incontinence*.

## **Bladder Infection**

Alternate index label; see *Cystitis*.

## **Bladder Inflammation**

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial cystitis*.

## **Bladder Prolapse**

Alternate index label; see *Anterior vaginal prolapse (cystocele)*.

## **Blastocystosis**

Alternate index label; see *Blastocystis hominis*.

## **Blocked Ureter**

Alternate index label; see *Ureteral obstruction*.

## **Body Odor And Sweating**

Alternate index label; see *Sweating and body odor*.

## **Bradycardia-Tachycardia Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Sick sinus syndrome*.

## **Brain Arteriovenous Malformation**

Alternate index label; see *Brain AVM (arteriove-*

*nous malformation)*.

## **Brain Embolism**

Alternate index label; see *Embolic stroke (brain embolism)*.

## **Brain Tumor, Child**

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric brain tumors*.

## **Breast Cancer, Inflammatory**

Alternate index label; see *Inflammatory breast cancer*.

## **Breast Cancer, Male**

Alternate index label; see *Male breast cancer*.

## **Broken Blood Vessel In Eye**

Alternate index label; see *Subconjunctival hemorrhage (broken blood vessel in eye)*.

## **Broken Clavicle**

Alternate index label; see *Broken collarbone*.

## **Broken Hip**

Alternate index label; see *Hip fracture*.

## **Burn Injury**

Alternate index label; see *Burns*.

## **Burning Thigh Pain**

Alternate index label; see *Meralgia paresthetica*.

## **Bunyaviruses**

Alternate index label; see *Viral hemorrhagic fevers*.

## **Burkitt's Tumor**

Alternate index label; see *Burkitt lymphoma*.

## **Bursitis Of The Knee**

Alternate index label; see *Knee bursitis*.

## **B And T Cell Screen**

B and T cell screen uses immunophenotyping to measure and characterize circulating B lymphocytes and



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T lymphocytes, supporting evaluation of immune deficiency, leukemia, and lymphoma.

### **B-Cell Leukemia/Lymphoma Panel**

B-cell leukemia/lymphoma panel uses flow cytometry and antibody markers to identify abnormal B-cell populations in blood, marrow, or tissue.

### **Bacitracin Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to bacitracin. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Bacitracin Zinc Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to bacitracin zinc. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Bacterial Vaginosis - Aftercare**

After treatment for bacterial vaginosis, care includes completing prescribed therapy, avoiding practices that disrupt vaginal flora, and seeking review for persistent or recurrent symptoms.

### **BAER - Brainstem Auditory Evoked Response**

BAER records electrical responses from the auditory nerve and brainstem after sound stimulation, helping assess hearing pathways when behavioral testing is difficult.

### **Baking Powder Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to baking powder. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Baking Soda Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to baking soda. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Barbiturate Intoxication And Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to a barbiturate medicine. Severe poisoning may cause central nervous system depression, respiratory failure, hypotension, or coma and requires emergency treatment.

### **Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess**

Bartholin cyst is a blocked gland duct near the vaginal opening; infection can produce a painful abscess requiring drainage and sometimes antibiotics.

### **Basal Cell Skin Cancer**

Basal cell skin cancer is a usually slow-growing skin malignancy arising from basal keratinocytes; it rarely metastasizes but can destroy nearby tissue if untreated.

### **Bassen-Kornzweig Syndrome**

Bassen-Kornzweig syndrome, or abetalipoproteinemia, is an inherited disorder of lipoprotein assembly causing fat malabsorption, acanthocytosis, vitamin E deficiency, and neurologic disease.

### **Bathing A Patient In Bed**

Safe bathing care involves maintaining water temperature, preventing falls or drowning, protecting skin, and providing assistance appropriate to the person's age and mobility.

### **Bathing An Infant**

Safe bathing care involves maintaining water temperature, preventing falls or drowning, protecting skin, and providing assistance appropriate to the person's age and mobility.

### **Bathroom Safety - Children**

Bathroom safety measures reduce falls, burns, drowning, and medication exposure through supervision, non-slip surfaces, grab supports, and secure storage.

### **Bathroom Safety For Adults**

Bathroom safety measures reduce falls, burns, drowning, and medication exposure through super-

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vision, non-slip surfaces, grab supports, and secure storage.

### **Bed Rest During Pregnancy**

Bed rest during pregnancy is a medical recommendation that restricts activity for a specific indication. Routine bed rest is not generally used because it can cause deconditioning and thromboembolism.

### **Bedtime Habits For Infants And Children**

Healthy bedtime habits for infants and children include a consistent routine, a safe sleep environment, and age-appropriate sleep duration.

### **Bee, Wasp, Hornet, Or Yellow Jacket Sting**

A clinical topic about bee, wasp, hornet, or yellow jacket sting. It includes the purpose, common findings, risks, and appropriate clinical follow-up.

### **Beeswax Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to beeswax. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Before Weight-Loss Surgery - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Preoperative information about weight-loss surgery, including preparation, expected benefits, risks, alternatives, and long-term follow-up.

### **Being Active After Your Heart Attack**

Physical activity after a heart attack or with heart disease should be gradual and individualized, usually with clinician guidance or cardiac rehabilitation.

### **Being Active When You Have Heart Disease**

Physical activity after a heart attack or with heart disease should be gradual and individualized, usually with clinician guidance or cardiac rehabilitation.

### **Benefits Of Breastfeeding**

Breastfeeding provides human milk containing nu-

trients and immune factors and may benefit infant and maternal health when it is safe and desired.

### **Benefits Of Quitting Tobacco**

Stopping tobacco use reduces cardiovascular, respiratory, cancer, and pregnancy-related risks, with benefits beginning soon after cessation.

### **Benign Ear Cyst Or Tumor**

A benign ear cyst or tumor is a noncancerous mass involving the external, middle, or inner ear. Symptoms and treatment depend on location and size.

### **Benign Positional Vertigo - Aftercare**

Benign positional vertigo aftercare covers activity, fall prevention, recurrence, and vestibular exercises after treatment for brief vertigo caused by displaced inner-ear otoconia.

### **Benign Prostate Hyperplasia (BPH) - Resources**

Information about benign prostatic hyperplasia, including urinary symptoms, evaluation, medicines, procedures, and follow-up.

### **Benzene Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to benzene. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Beta-Blockers Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to beta-blockers. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Beta-Carotene Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate beta-carotene or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Bicycle Safety**

Bicycle safety includes helmet use, visibility, traffic awareness, suitable equipment, and supervision

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appropriate to age and skill.

### **Bilateral Hydronephrosis**

Bilateral hydronephrosis is enlargement of both renal collecting systems from impaired urine drainage, with causes including obstruction, reflux, stones, or bladder dysfunction.

### **Bilateral Tonic-Clonic Seizure**

A bilateral tonic-clonic seizure causes loss of consciousness followed by stiffening and rhythmic jerking of both sides of the body.

### **Bile Acid Sequestrants For Cholesterol**

Medicines that bind bile acids in the intestine and lower low-density lipoprotein cholesterol by increasing hepatic conversion of cholesterol into bile acids.

### **Bile Culture**

A laboratory culture of bile to identify bacteria or fungi in suspected biliary infection.

### **Bile Duct Obstruction**

Impaired flow of bile through the biliary tract, causing jaundice, dark urine, pale stools, itching, abdominal pain, or infection.

### **Bile Duct Stricture**

Narrowing of a bile duct that impairs bile flow and may cause jaundice, abdominal pain, cholangitis, or abnormal liver tests.

### **Bili Lights**

Phototherapy lights used to treat neonatal jaundice by converting bilirubin into forms that can be eliminated more easily.

### **Biliary System**

The network of liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts that produces, stores, and transports bile to the intestine.

### **Bilirubin - Urine**

A urine test for conjugated bilirubin. Its presence may indicate cholestasis or hepatocellular disease

because unconjugated bilirubin is not normally excreted in urine.

### **Bilirubin Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate bilirubin or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Biopsy - Biliary Tract**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Birth Control - Slow Release Methods**

Information about contraceptive methods, including effectiveness, use, adverse effects, contraindications, and reproductive planning.

### **Birth Control And Family Planning**

Information about contraceptive methods, including effectiveness, use, adverse effects, contraindications, and reproductive planning.

### **Birth Control Pill Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to birth control pill. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Birth Control Pills**

Information about contraceptive methods, including effectiveness, use, adverse effects, contraindications, and reproductive planning.

### **Birth Control Pills - Combination**

Information about contraceptive methods, including effectiveness, use, adverse effects, contraindications, and reproductive planning.

### **Birth Control Pills - Progestin Only**

Information about contraceptive methods, including effectiveness, use, adverse effects, contraindications, and reproductive planning.

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### **Birthmarks - Pigmented**

Pigmented birthmarks are localized areas of increased or altered skin pigmentation present at birth or appearing early in life. Changes in size, color, or shape require assessment.

### **Black Nightshade Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to black nightshade. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Black Or Tarry Stools**

Black or tarry stools may indicate upper gastrointestinal bleeding, but can also result from iron or bismuth. New or persistent findings require medical assessment.

### **Black Widow Spider**

The black widow spider is a venomous spider whose bite can cause severe muscle pain, abdominal cramping, sweating, hypertension, and autonomic symptoms.

### **Bladder Biopsy**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Bladder Exstrophy Repair**

Bladder exstrophy repair reconstructs the exposed bladder and lower abdominal and genital structures present in this congenital defect, often through staged surgery.

### **Bland Diet**

A bland diet consists of foods that are soft, mildly seasoned, and low in irritants. It may be used temporarily for selected gastrointestinal symptoms.

### **Bleeding During Cancer Treatment**

A clinical topic about bleeding during cancer treatment. It includes the purpose, common findings, risks, and appropriate clinical follow-up.

### **Bleeding Into The Skin**

A clinical topic about bleeding into the skin. It includes the purpose, common findings, risks, and appropriate clinical follow-up.

### **Blindness - Resources**

Resources for blindness provide information about low-vision services, mobility training, assistive devices, rehabilitation, and support.

### **Blindness And Vision Loss**

Blindness or vision loss is reduced visual function that may result from eye disease, optic-nerve disease, brain disease, injury, or congenital conditions.

### **Blockage Of Upper Airway**

Upper-airway obstruction prevents normal airflow through the nose, mouth, pharynx, or larynx and can rapidly cause respiratory failure.

### **Blood Differential Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate blood differential or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Blood Donation Before Surgery**

A medical procedure involving blood donation before surgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Blood Gases**

Laboratory measurements of oxygen, carbon dioxide, acidity, and related values in blood to assess ventilation, oxygenation, and acid-base balance.

### **Blood In The Semen**

Blood in semen, called hematospermia, is usually benign and self-limited but may result from infection, inflammation, trauma, or a urologic disorder.

### **Blood Pressure Measurement**

Measurement of the pressure exerted by circulating blood on arterial walls, recorded as systolic and diastolic pressure.

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### **Blood Pressure Monitors For Home**

Devices used to measure blood pressure outside a clinic. Accurate cuff size, positioning, and repeated measurements improve reliability.

### **Blood Transfusions**

A medical procedure involving blood transfusions. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Blood Typing**

Laboratory determination of ABO and Rh blood-group antigens to support safe transfusion and pregnancy-related care.

### **Bloodborne Pathogens**

Bloodborne pathogens are infectious agents transmitted through blood or certain body fluids, including HIV, hepatitis B virus, and hepatitis C virus.

### **Blue Discoloration Of The Skin**

Bluish discoloration of the skin or mucous membranes, called cyanosis, may indicate reduced oxygenation or abnormal blood flow.

### **Blue Nightshade Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to blue nightshade. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Body Temperature Norms**

Normal body temperature varies with age, time of day, activity, measurement site, and health. Fever and hypothermia are defined using clinical context and measurement method.

### **Boils**

Boils are localized infections of hair follicles, usually caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*, that form painful pus-filled nodules.

#### **Synonyms:**

Abscesses Skin (Boils)

### **Bonding With Your Newborn**

Bonding with a newborn is the development of an emotional relationship through responsive caregiving, touch, feeding, and interaction.

### **Bone Lesion Biopsy**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Bone Marrow (Stem Cell) Donation**

Bone marrow or stem-cell donation is collection of blood-forming stem cells from marrow or circulating blood for transplantation into another person.

### **Bone Marrow Culture**

A laboratory culture of bone-marrow material used to identify bacteria, fungi, or other organisms in suspected infection.

### **Bone Marrow Transplant**

A treatment in which healthy hematopoietic stem cells replace or restore blood-forming cells after conditioning therapy. Recovery requires monitoring for infection, graft failure, and graft-versus-host disease.

### **Bone Marrow Transplant - Discharge**

A treatment in which healthy hematopoietic stem cells replace or restore blood-forming cells after conditioning therapy. Recovery requires monitoring for infection, graft failure, and graft-versus-host disease.

### **Bone Marrow Transplant In Children - Discharge**

A treatment in which healthy hematopoietic stem cells replace or restore blood-forming cells after conditioning therapy. Recovery requires monitoring for infection, graft failure, and graft-versus-host disease.

### **Bone Mineral Density Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate bone mineral density or related findings. Results are interpreted

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with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Bone Pain Or Tenderness**

Bone pain or tenderness may result from injury, infection, metabolic disease, inflammation, or cancer. Persistent or unexplained pain requires assessment.

### **Bone Tumor**

A mass arising in bone that may be benign or malignant. Evaluation uses imaging and biopsy when indicated.

### **Bone X-Ray**

An X-ray examination used to assess the specified body region for fracture, abnormal structure, or disease.

### **Boric Acid Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to boric acid. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, co-existing conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Botulinum Toxin Injection - Larynx**

A medical procedure involving botulinum toxin injection - larynx. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Bowel Retraining**

Bowel retraining is a structured program using regular timing, adequate fluid and fiber, toileting posture, and other measures to establish predictable bowel movements.

### **Bowel Transit Time**

Bowel transit time is the time required for material to pass through the gastrointestinal tract, measured to evaluate selected motility disorders.

### **Brachial Plexus Injury In Newborns**

A brachial plexus injury in a newborn affects the network of nerves supplying the shoulder, arm, and hand, usually after difficult delivery. Weakness may

improve or require specialist care.

### **Brain Aneurysm Repair**

A medical procedure involving brain aneurysm repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Brain Aneurysm Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving brain aneurysm repair - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Brain Injury - Discharge**

Discharge care after brain injury includes supervision, medication management, activity guidance, and monitoring for worsening headache, confusion, vomiting, seizure, or weakness.

### **Brain Natriuretic Peptide Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate brain natriuretic peptide or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Brain PET Scan**

A positron-emission tomography study that shows metabolic or molecular activity in the brain using a radioactive tracer.

### **Brain Radiation - Discharge**

Discharge care after brain radiation includes skin and symptom care, medication instructions, monitoring for neurologic changes, and scheduled follow-up.

### **Brain Surgery**

A medical procedure involving brain surgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Brain Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving brain surgery - dis-



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charge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Brain Tumor - Children**

A primary brain tumor is an abnormal growth arising in brain tissue or nearby structures. It may be benign or malignant and can cause neurologic symptoms through invasion or pressure.

### **Brain Tumor - Primary - Adults**

A primary brain tumor is an abnormal growth arising in brain tissue or nearby structures. It may be benign or malignant and can cause neurologic symptoms through invasion or pressure.

### **BRCA1 And BRCA2 Gene Testing**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate *brca1* and *brca2* gene testing or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Break The Bonds Of Emotional Eating**

Emotional eating is eating in response to stress or other emotions rather than physical hunger. Management may include behavioral strategies and treatment of underlying conditions.

### **Breast Augmentation Surgery**

A medical procedure involving breast augmentation surgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Breast Biopsy - Stereotactic**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Breast Biopsy - Ultrasound**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Breast Cancer In Men**

Breast cancer in men is a malignant tumor of male breast tissue, usually presenting as a painless lump or nipple change and requiring diagnostic imaging and biopsy.

### **Breast Cancer Screening**

Testing used to detect breast cancer before symptoms develop, usually with mammography and, for selected patients, additional imaging.

### **Breast Cancer Staging**

Breast cancer staging describes the extent of disease using tumor features, lymph-node involvement, and distant spread to guide prognosis and treatment.

### **Breast Enlargement In Males**

Enlargement of male breast tissue, called gynecomastia, caused by glandular proliferation. Causes include hormonal changes, medicines, obesity, and systemic disease.

### **Breast External Beam Radiation - Discharge**

Discharge care after breast external-beam radiation includes skin care, symptom monitoring, treatment completion, and follow-up.

### **Breast Lift**

A breast lift, or mastopexy, surgically reshapes and raises sagging breast tissue by removing excess skin and repositioning the nipple when necessary.

### **Breast Lump Removal**

A medical procedure involving breast lump removal. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Breast Milk - Pumping And Storing**

Guidance on expressing, storing, labeling, and handling breast milk to preserve safety and nutritional quality.

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### **Breast MRI Scan**

A magnetic resonance imaging study that produces detailed images of the specified body region using magnetic fields and radiofrequency energy.

### **Breast Reconstruction - Implants**

A medical procedure involving breast reconstruction - implants. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Breast Reconstruction - Natural Tissue**

A medical procedure involving breast reconstruction - natural tissue. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Breast Reduction**

Breast reduction, or reduction mammoplasty, removes breast tissue, fat, and skin to reduce breast size and related symptoms.

### **Breast Self-Exam**

Breast self-examination is personal observation and palpation for new changes. It does not replace recommended screening or clinical evaluation.

### **Breast Skin And Nipple Changes**

Changes in breast skin or the nipple may result from benign conditions, infection, hormonal change, or cancer. New, persistent, or one-sided changes require assessment.

### **Breastfeeding - Resources**

Breastfeeding resources provide information about feeding technique, lactation support, maternal medicines, infant feeding, and common problems.

### **Breastfeeding - Self-Care**

Breastfeeding self-care includes breast and nipple care, adequate hydration and nutrition, pain management, and assessment of fever or persistent breast symptoms.

### **Breastfeeding - Skin And Nipple Changes**

Breastfeeding-related skin or nipple changes may result from friction, dermatitis, infection, or other causes and require assessment when persistent or painful.

### **Breastfeeding Vs. Formula Feeding**

Breastfeeding and formula feeding are methods of infant nutrition. Choice depends on medical factors, feeding goals, access to support, and family preference.

### **Breath Alcohol Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate breath alcohol or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Breath Odor**

Unpleasant breath odor, or halitosis, commonly results from oral disease, dry mouth, tobacco, diet, or infection.

### **Breath-Holding Spell**

A brief involuntary episode in a young child, usually after crying or upset, involving apnea, color change, and rapid recovery.

### **Breathing - Slowed Or Stopped**

Slowed or absent breathing, called respiratory depression or apnea, can result from airway obstruction, medicines, neurologic disease, or severe illness and requires immediate assessment.

### **Breathing Difficulties - First Aid**

Breathing difficulty, or dyspnea, is a subjective sensation of difficult or uncomfortable breathing that may result from lung, heart, blood, metabolic, or other disorders.

### **Breathing Difficulty**

Breathing difficulty, or dyspnea, is a subjective sensation of difficult or uncomfortable breathing that may result from lung, heart, blood, metabolic, or other disorders.

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## **Breathing Difficulty - Lying Down**

Breathing difficulty, or dyspnea, is a subjective sensation of difficult or uncomfortable breathing that may result from lung, heart, blood, metabolic, or other disorders.

## **Breech Birth**

A breech birth occurs when the fetus presents buttocks or feet first rather than the head. Delivery planning depends on fetal position, gestational age, and maternal and fetal factors.

## **Brief Resolved Unexplained Event - BRUE**

A brief resolved unexplained event is a sudden, brief, and resolved episode in an infant involving altered breathing, color, muscle tone, or responsiveness without an identifiable cause after evaluation.

## **Bringing Your Child To Visit A Very Ill Sibling**

Preparing a child to visit a seriously ill sibling includes age-appropriate explanation, emotional support, and attention to infection-control and safety requirements.

## **Broad Nasal Bridge**

A broad nasal bridge is increased width of the upper nose. It may be a normal familial feature or part of a congenital or genetic syndrome.

## **Broken Bone**

A broken bone, or fracture, is a partial or complete disruption of bone continuity caused by injury, repetitive stress, or weakened bone.

## **Broken Collarbone - Aftercare**

Aftercare for a broken collarbone includes protection of the fracture, pain control, activity guidance, and follow-up to assess healing.

## **Broken Kneecap - Aftercare**

Aftercare for a broken kneecap includes protection of the knee, pain control, mobility guidance, and follow-up to assess bone and extensor-mechanism

healing.

## **Broken Or Dislocated Jaw**

A fracture or dislocation of the jaw can cause pain, swelling, malocclusion, limited movement, and difficulty speaking or swallowing.

## **Broken Or Knocked Out Tooth**

A broken or avulsed tooth is a dental injury caused by trauma. An avulsed permanent tooth requires urgent dental care.

## **Broken Toe - Self-Care**

Self-care for a broken toe includes protection, suitable footwear, pain control, and monitoring for deformity, numbness, impaired circulation, or infection.

## **Brompheniramine Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to brompheniramine. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## **Bronchiolitis - Discharge**

Home care after bronchiolitis includes hydration, monitoring breathing and feeding, avoiding smoke exposure, and seeking urgent care for worsening respiratory distress.

## **Bronchoscopic Culture**

Bronchoscopic culture examines respiratory specimens collected through bronchoscopy for bacteria, fungi, or mycobacteria when ordinary samples are inadequate.

## **Bronchoscopy - Aftercare**

Bronchoscopy aftercare includes observation for breathing difficulty, bleeding, fever, chest pain, and swallowing recovery after an airway examination or sampling procedure.

## **Brown Recluse Spider**

The brown recluse spider is a venomous spider whose bite may cause local tissue injury and, rarely, sys-

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temic illness.

### **Bruised Rib Care**

Care for a bruised rib includes pain control, normal gentle breathing, activity modification, and assessment for shortness of breath or other chest injury.

### **Brushing Your Child's Teeth**

Brushing a child's teeth removes plaque and helps prevent dental caries and gum disease. Fluoride toothpaste and age-appropriate supervision are recommended.

### **Bubble Bath Soap Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to bubble bath soap. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Buccal Smear**

A laboratory examination of cells collected from the specified site to identify abnormal, infectious, or malignant changes.

### **Bug Repellent Safety**

Bug-repellent safety concerns appropriate product selection, application, storage, and prevention of skin, eye, inhalation, or ingestion exposure.

### **Bug Spray Poisoning**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to bug spray. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **BUN - Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate bun or related findings. Results are interpreted with the test method, clinical findings, and reference range.

### **Bunion Removal**

A medical procedure involving bunion removal. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Bunion Removal - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving bunion removal - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Burns - Resources**

Burn-care resources provide information about first aid, wound care, infection prevention, pain control, and indications for specialist treatment.

### **Bursitis Of The Heel**

Heel bursitis is inflammation of a fluid-filled bursa near the heel, producing localized tenderness and pain with pressure or walking.

### **Butazolidin Overdose**

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to butazolidin. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, coexisting conditions, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

### **Butter, Margarine, And Cooking Oils**

Butter, margarine, and cooking oils are dietary fat sources. Their nutritional effects depend on portion size, fatty-acid composition, and the overall eating pattern.

### **Button Batteries**

Button batteries are small batteries that can cause severe tissue injury if swallowed or inserted into the nose or ear. Suspected ingestion requires emergency evaluation.

### **Buying And Caring For Baby Bottles And Nipples**

Safe selection and cleaning of baby bottles and nipples reduce contamination, feeding injury, and improper preparation risks.

### **B Hemophilia (Hemophilia)**

Alternate index label for Hemophilia.

### **Bacterial Vaginosis (Causes, Symptoms,**

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## **Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Causes, Symptoms, Treatment.

## **Bakers Cyst (Baker Cyst)**

Alternate index label for Baker Cyst.

## **Balanitis (Penis Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Penis Disorder.

## **Barlow Syndrome (Mitral Valve Prolapse)**

Alternate index label for Mitral Valve Prolapse.

## **Barretts Esophagus (Barrett's Esophagus)**

Alternate index label for Barrett's Esophagus.

## **Bedbugs Bed Bugs Vs Lice**

Bedbugs and head lice are different parasites. Bedbugs live in the environment and bite exposed skin, while head lice live on the scalp and spread mainly through close contact; inspection of the insect, eggs, and usual body site distinguishes them.

## **Bedbugs Bite (Bed Bugs)**

Alternate index label for Bed Bugs.

## **Bedbugs Contagious (Are Bedbugs Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Are Bedbugs Contagious.

## **Bee And Wasp Sting**

Bee and wasp stings inject venom and usually cause immediate localized pain, redness, swelling, and itching. Widespread hives, throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, dizziness, or vomiting may indicate anaphylaxis and require emergency treatment.

## **Behcet's Syndrome**

Behcet syndrome is a relapsing inflammatory disorder that can cause recurrent mouth and genital ulcers, eye inflammation, skin lesions, and vascular, neurologic, or gastrointestinal disease. Treatment is tailored to the organs involved and may include

immunosuppression.

## **Synonyms:**

Silk Road Disease (Behcet's Syndrome)

## **Being Good Partner To Someone With Chronic Illness**

Supporting a partner with chronic illness involves listening, respecting autonomy, sharing practical tasks by agreement, and recognizing fluctuating symptoms and treatment demands. Clear communication, respite, boundaries, and professional or peer support help protect both partners' well-being.

## **Bells Palsy (Facial Nerve Problems)**

Alternate index label for Facial Nerve Problems.

## **Benefits And Risks Of Taking Amino Acid Supplement**

Amino-acid supplements may be useful for a documented deficiency or a specific clinical indication, but most people obtain adequate amino acids from protein-containing foods. Excessive or unnecessary use can cause gastrointestinal symptoms, metabolic effects, interactions, or kidney and liver concerns.

## **Benefits Of Taking Magnesium Glycinate?**

Magnesium glycinate is a magnesium salt often marketed for deficiency, muscle symptoms, or sleep. Evidence for specific benefits varies; supplements can cause diarrhea or excess magnesium, and kidney disease increases toxicity risk, so dose and indication should be reviewed.

## **Bernard-Soulier Disease**

Bernard-Soulier disease is a rare inherited platelet disorder caused by defects in the platelet glycoprotein Ib-IX-V complex. Platelets are unusually large and do not adhere normally, producing mucocutaneous bleeding, easy bruising, and prolonged bleeding after procedures.

## **Best Foods To Eat For Constipation Relief (Top Foods For Constipation Relief)**

Alternate index label for Top Foods For Constipation

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tion Relief.

### **Best Foods To Eat When You Have Gallstones**

For gallstones, meals lower in saturated fat and moderate in portion size may reduce symptoms in people whose pain follows fatty foods. No food dissolves most gallstones; recurrent right-upper-abdominal pain, fever, jaundice, or vomiting needs medical assessment.

### **Best Fruits For Lowering Blood Pressure**

Fruits such as citrus, berries, bananas, and other potassium- and fiber-containing choices can support a blood-pressure-friendly eating pattern. They complement, but do not replace, prescribed treatment, sodium reduction, physical activity, and monitoring.

### **Best Home Remedies For Upper Respiratory Infection**

Most uncomplicated upper-respiratory infections improve with rest, fluids, humidified air, saline nasal care, and appropriate symptom relief. Antibiotics do not treat viral infections; breathing difficulty, dehydration, persistent high fever, or worsening symptoms needs evaluation.

### **Best Home Remedies For Vaginal Itching**

Vaginal itching may result from yeast, bacterial vaginosis, sexually transmitted infection, irritant dermatitis, hormonal change, or skin disease. Avoiding scented products and keeping the area dry may help, but recurrent, painful, malodorous, or discharge-associated symptoms need diagnosis before treatment.

### **Best Infusion For Rheumatoid Arthritis (RA)**

Alternate index label for RA.

### **Best Medicinal Mushroom Health Benefits**

Medicinal mushrooms are marketed for immune, metabolic, or cancer-related benefits, but evidence and product standardization differ substantially by species and preparation. They should not replace

proven treatment and may cause allergy, toxicity, or medicine interactions.

### **Best Medicine And Treatment For Bronchitis**

Acute bronchitis is usually viral and improves with fluids, rest, and symptom-directed care; antibiotics rarely help unless another bacterial diagnosis is present. Persistent breathlessness, high fever, bloody sputum, chest pain, or symptoms in a high-risk person warrants evaluation.

### **Best Natural Treatments For Gastritis**

Gastritis treatment depends on the cause, including *Helicobacter pylori*, anti-inflammatory medicines, alcohol, bile reflux, or autoimmune disease. Avoiding irritants may reduce symptoms, but persistent pain, bleeding, vomiting, anemia, or weight loss requires medical diagnosis and targeted therapy.

### **Best Temperature For Roasting Vegetables**

Roasting vegetables commonly uses a moderately high oven temperature, with time adjusted for the vegetable, size, moisture, and desired texture. Safe food handling and avoiding charring are more important than a single universal temperature.

### **Best Thing To Eat For Breakfast To Lose Weight**

A weight-supportive breakfast can combine protein, fiber, fruit or vegetables, and a portion that fits daily energy needs. No single food causes weight loss; sustainable intake, activity, sleep, medications, and medical conditions determine long-term change.

### **Best Time To Measure Your Blood Pressure**

Blood pressure is best compared when measured under consistent conditions, after several minutes of rest and before exercise, caffeine, smoking, or medications when instructed. Repeated readings at similar times provide more useful information than one isolated measurement.

### **Best Treatment For Degenerative Disc**



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## Disease

Degenerative disc disease describes age- or wear-related changes in spinal discs and does not always cause pain. Treatment usually begins with activity modification, exercise-based rehabilitation, and pain management; selected patients may need injections or surgery after specialist assessment.

## Best Treatment For Hidradenitis Suppurativa

Hidradenitis suppurativa causes recurrent painful nodules, abscesses, and tunnels in skin folds. Management may include weight and smoking support, antiseptic care, antibiotics, hormonal or biologic medicines, injections, and surgery according to severity.

## Best Treatment For Yellow Jacket Stings

A yellow-jacket sting should be washed, and a cold pack can reduce local pain and swelling. Remove any visible bee stinger without squeezing, use symptom relief as appropriate, and seek emergency care for hives away from the site, breathing trouble, throat swelling, faintness, or vomiting.

## Best Treatment Options For Acne Rosacea

Rosacea treatment reduces flushing, persistent redness, bumps, and eye symptoms through trigger avoidance, gentle skin care, sunscreen, and selected topical or oral medicines. The regimen depends on subtype, severity, ocular involvement, and response.

## Best Treatments For Allergic Conjunctivitis

Allergic conjunctivitis causes itchy, watery, red eyes after exposure to an allergen. Limiting exposure, cool compresses, lubricating drops, and antihistamine or mast-cell-stabilizing eye medicines can help; severe pain, vision loss, or marked light sensitivity suggests another urgent eye problem.

## Best Way To Treat Razor Bumps From Shaving

Razor bumps are inflammatory ingrown hairs caused by shaving or hair removal. Pausing close shaving,

using a clean sharp tool, shaving with hair growth, avoiding skin stretching, and selected topical treatment can reduce recurrence; widespread infection or scarring needs care.

## Beyond Food What Triggers Heartburn And GERD

Heartburn and gastroesophageal reflux can be triggered by lying down after meals, obesity, pregnancy, smoking, alcohol, certain medicines, large meals, and individual foods. Persistent symptoms, difficulty swallowing, bleeding, weight loss, or chest pain require medical evaluation.

## Bible Cyst (Ganglion)

Alternate index label for Ganglion.

## Bile Duct Cancer (Cholangiocarcinoma)

Alternate index label for Cholangiocarcinoma.

## Bilharzia (Schistosomiasis)

Alternate index label for Schistosomiasis.

## Biliary Cirrhosis Primary (Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC))

Alternate index label for Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC).

## Bilirubin (Bilirubin And Bilirubin Blood Test)

Alternate index label for Bilirubin and Bilirubin Blood Test.

## Bilirubin And Bilirubin Blood Test

Bilirubin is a yellow pigment produced when red blood cells are broken down. A blood test measures total and sometimes direct and indirect bilirubin to help evaluate liver disease, bile-duct obstruction, hemolysis, and newborn jaundice.

### Synonyms:

Bilirubin (Bilirubin And Bilirubin Blood Test)

## Biorhythms

Biorhythms is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its

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defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bioterrorism**

Bioterrorism is the deliberate release of biological agents to cause illness, death, or disruption. Preparedness includes surveillance, laboratory identification, public-health communication, vaccination or prophylaxis when indicated, and rapid isolation or treatment of exposed people.

### **Birth Control Methods**

Birth-control methods include condoms, pills, implants, injections, intrauterine devices, patches, rings, fertility-awareness approaches, and permanent contraception. Effectiveness, sexually transmitted infection protection, side effects, reversibility, and medical eligibility vary by method.

### **Birth Control Pill Vs. Depo-Provera Shot**

Combined or progestin-only pills require regular dosing, whereas the depot medroxyprogesterone injection provides contraception for about three months at a time. Both are effective when used correctly, but bleeding changes, bone-health considerations, contraindications, return to fertility, and adherence differ.

### **Birthmarks And Other Skin Pigmentation Problems**

Birthmarks and pigment changes may reflect vascular lesions, melanocytic cells, post-inflammatory change, medication, hormonal conditions, or genetic disease. A lesion that changes rapidly, bleeds, ulcerates, or differs from others should be examined.

### **Bite Chigger (Chiggers (Bites))**

Alternate index label for Chiggers (Bites).

### **Bite Dog (Dog Bite Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Dog Bite Treatment.

### **Bite Snake (Snake Bite)**

Alternate index label for Snake Bite.

### **Bites Flea (Flea Bites In Humans)**

Alternate index label for Flea Bites in Humans.

### **Bladder Carcinoma (Bladder Cancer)**

Alternate index label for Bladder Cancer.

### **Bladder Infection (Urinary Tract Infection)**

Alternate index label for Urinary Tract Infection.

### **Bleeding After Not Having A Period For 10 Years**

Any vaginal bleeding after menopause requires medical evaluation, even when it is light or occurs once. Causes include thinning tissue, polyps, hormone effects, and cancer; examination and often ultrasound or endometrial sampling determine the source.

### **Bleeding Varices**

Varices are enlarged, fragile veins, commonly in the esophagus or stomach when portal pressure is high. Rupture causes life-threatening gastrointestinal bleeding with vomiting blood, black stool, weakness, or shock and requires emergency treatment.

### **Bloated (Why Am I So Bloated)**

Alternate index label for Why Am I So Bloated.

### **Blood Cancer (Leukemia)**

Alternate index label for Leukemia.

### **Blood Clot In The Lung (Pulmonary Embolism)**

Alternate index label for Pulmonary Embolism.

### **Blood In The Stool (Rectal Bleeding)**

Alternate index label for Rectal Bleeding.

### **Blood In Urine**

Blood in the urine, or hematuria, may arise from infection, stones, prostate disease, kidney disease, trauma, medicines, or urinary-tract cancer. Visible blood, clots, pain, fever, inability to urinate, or persistent microscopic blood requires timely evaluation.

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## **Blood Low Red Cell Count (Anemia)**

Alternate index label for Anemia.

## **Blood Pressure Chart: Reading By Age**

Blood-pressure interpretation depends on repeated measurements, technique, age, pregnancy, comorbidities, and the guideline used; age alone does not define a safe target. Very high readings with chest pain, neurologic symptoms, shortness of breath, or confusion are emergencies.

## **Blood Pressure Low (Low Blood Pressure)**

Low blood pressure can be normal or can result from dehydration, bleeding, infection, heart disease, endocrine disease, or medicines. Symptoms such as fainting, confusion, chest pain, severe weakness, or shock require urgent assessment.

## **Blood When I Wipe: 11 Causes Of Rectal Bleeding**

Blood on toilet paper may come from hemorrhoids, anal fissure, irritation, infection, inflammatory bowel disease, polyps, or colorectal cancer. The amount, color, pain, bowel changes, age, and recurrence guide evaluation; heavy bleeding or faintness is urgent.

## **Body Type Ectomorph, Endomorph Or Mesomorph**

Ectomorph, endomorph, and mesomorph are informal body-type categories that do not reliably predict metabolism, health, or exercise response. Fitness and nutrition decisions are better based on measured health, goals, activity, and individual response.

## **Bone Cancer Overview**

Primary bone cancer is a malignant tumor arising in bone, while cancer more commonly spreads to bone from another organ. Persistent focal bone pain, swelling, or an unexplained fracture may prompt imaging and biopsy; treatment depends on tumor type and stage.

### **Synonyms:**

Bone Tumor (Bone Cancer Overview)

## **Bone Fractures (Broken Bone (Types Of Bone Fractures))**

Alternate index label for Broken Bone (Types of Bone Fractures).

## **Bone Tumor (Bone Cancer Overview)**

Alternate index label for Bone Cancer Overview.

## **Bottom Number Of Your Blood Pressure Is Over 100**

A diastolic blood-pressure reading over 100 mm Hg is markedly elevated when confirmed with correct repeated measurements. Persistent elevation increases cardiovascular risk, while a very high reading with chest pain, breathlessness, neurologic symptoms, or confusion needs urgent care.

## **BPD (Borderline Personality Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Borderline Personality Disorder.

## **BPH (Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia)**

Alternate index label for Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia.

## **BPH Vs. Prostatitis (Prostatitis Vs BPH Enlarged Prostate Gland)**

Benign prostatic hyperplasia and prostatitis are different conditions: the former enlarges prostate tissue, while the latter is inflammation or infection of the prostate.

## **Braces And Retainers (Dental Braces)**

Alternate index label for Dental Braces.

## **Brain Aneurysm**

A brain aneurysm is a weakened area of a cerebral artery that can enlarge and rupture. Rupture causes sudden severe headache, vomiting, neck stiffness, loss of consciousness, or neurologic deficits and is a medical emergency.

## **Brain Cancer**

Brain cancer consists of malignant tumors arising in or affecting brain tissue and its coverings. Sym-

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toms depend on location and may include seizures, headache, weakness, speech or vision changes, personality change, or raised intracranial pressure; diagnosis uses imaging and tissue characterization.

**Synonyms:**

Tumor Brain Cancer (Brain Cancer)

**Brain Hemorrhage**

A brain hemorrhage is bleeding within or around the brain, often from hypertension, aneurysm, vascular malformation, trauma, or blood-thinning treatment. Sudden headache, weakness, speech difficulty, vomiting, seizure, or reduced consciousness requires emergency evaluation.

**Brain Injury (Head Injury)**

Alternate index label for Head Injury.

**Brain Lesions (Lesions On The Brain)**

Alternate index label for Lesions on the Brain.

**Branchial Cleft Cyst (Branchial Cyst)**

Alternate index label for Branchial Cyst.

**Branchial Cyst**

A branchial cyst is a congenital, usually benign fluid-filled lesion along an embryonic branchial-cleft remnant in the neck. It may present as a painless mass or become infected; examination and imaging guide management, and new adult neck masses require evaluation.

**Synonyms:**

Branchial Cleft Cyst (Branchial Cyst)

**Braxton Hicks Vs. True Labor Contractions**

Braxton Hicks contractions are usually irregular, do not progressively intensify, and may ease with rest or hydration. True labor contractions become longer, stronger, and closer together and lead to cervical change; rupture of membranes, bleeding, or decreased fetal movement requires obstetric advice.

**Breast Anatomy**

The breast contains skin, fat, lobules that produce

milk, ducts, connective tissue, blood vessels, nerves, and lymphatic drainage, extending toward the axilla. Normal structure varies with age, hormones, pregnancy, and lactation; a new persistent lump or skin change needs assessment.

**Breast Cancer (Facts, Stages)**

Breast cancer is an uncontrolled growth of breast cells that may invade nearby tissue or spread to lymph nodes and distant organs. Stage reflects tumor size, nodes, and metastasis; receptor status and other biology also guide surgery, radiation, endocrine treatment, chemotherapy, or targeted therapy.

**Synonyms:**

Cancer Inflammatory Breast (Breast Cancer (Facts, Stages))

**Breast Cancer And Coping With Stress**

Stress during breast-cancer diagnosis and treatment can affect sleep, mood, concentration, relationships, and adherence but does not mean a person caused the cancer. Counseling, support groups, exercise when safe, symptom treatment, and oncology or mental-health care can help.

**Synonyms:**

Stress Breast Cancer (Breast Cancer And Coping With Stress)

**Breast Cancer And Lymphedema**

Breast-cancer treatment can impair lymph drainage and cause swelling, heaviness, tightness, or skin changes in the arm, breast, or chest. Early assessment, compression when appropriate, exercise, skin protection, and specialized therapy can limit progression and complications.

**Breast Cancer Prevention**

Breast-cancer risk can be lowered but not eliminated through physical activity, healthy weight, limiting alcohol, avoiding tobacco, appropriate screening, and discussing inherited risk. Preventive medicines or surgery may be considered for people at substantially elevated risk.

**Breast Cancer Questions To Ask The**

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## Doctor

Useful breast-cancer questions cover the pathology, stage, receptor and genetic results, treatment goals, alternatives, benefits, side effects, fertility, clinical trials, and follow-up. Written notes and a support person can help with complex decisions.

## Breast Cancer Recurrence

Breast-cancer recurrence is return of cancer after treatment, either near the original site, in regional nodes, or at distant sites. New lumps, bone pain, persistent cough, neurologic symptoms, or other concerning changes should be evaluated, but many symptoms have noncancer causes.

## Breast Implants Before Or After Pregnancy

Pregnancy after breast implants is usually possible, but breast shape and volume may change and breastfeeding ability depends on the operation and duct or nerve effects. Implant rupture, capsular contracture, pain, or new breast changes require surgical assessment.

## Breast Lumps In Women

A breast lump may be a cyst, fibroadenoma, infection, hormonal change, trauma-related finding, or cancer. Clinical examination and age-appropriate imaging, with biopsy when indicated, determine the cause; a new hard, fixed, enlarging, or skin-associated lump needs prompt review.

### Synonyms:

Women Breast Lumps (Breast Lumps In Women)

## Breastfeeding With Rheumatoid Arthritis

People with rheumatoid arthritis may be able to breastfeed, but disease activity, fatigue, hand function, and medicine safety must be considered. Some medicines are compatible and others require avoidance or timing changes; treatment should be planned with rheumatology and obstetric or pediatric clinicians.

## Breath Bad (Bad Breath)

Alternate index label for Bad Breath.

## Breathing Disorders Sleep Related (Sleep Related Breathing Disorders)

Alternate index label for Sleep Related Breathing Disorders.

## Brittle Bone Disease (Osteogenesis Imperfecta Brittle Bone Disease)

Alternate index label for Osteogenesis Imperfecta Brittle Bone Disease.

## Broken Bone (Types Of Bone Fractures)

Alternate index label for Types of Bone Fractures.

## Bronchial Asthma (Asthma Overview)

Alternate index label for Asthma Overview.

## Bronchiectasis (Acquired, Congenital)

Alternate index label for Acquired, Congenital.

## Bronchitis (Acute)

Alternate index label for Acute.

## Bronchitis Chronic (Chronic Bronchitis)

Alternate index label for Chronic Bronchitis.

## Brown Recluse (Spider Bites (Black Widow And Brown Recluse))

Alternate index label for Spider Bites (Black Widow and Brown Recluse).

## Brucellosis Facts

Brucellosis is a bacterial infection acquired from unpasteurized dairy products or contact with infected animals or tissues. It can cause prolonged fever, sweats, fatigue, joint or back pain, and organ complications and requires prolonged combination antibiotic treatment.

### Synonyms:

Mediterranean Fever (Brucellosis Facts)

## Bruises

A bruise is bleeding beneath the skin after small blood vessels are damaged. Frequent, large, spontaneous, painful, or unusually persistent bruises may reflect medicines, platelet or clotting disorders, liver

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disease, nutritional deficiency, or injury and should be assessed.

### **Bruxism (Teeth Grinding (Bruxism))**

Alternate index label for Teeth Grinding (Bruxism).

### **Bullying**

Bullying is repeated aggression or intimidation involving a power imbalance and can be physical, verbal, social, or digital. It is associated with anxiety, depression, sleep problems, injury, school avoidance, and self-harm risk; safety planning and adult intervention are important.

### **Burns First Aid (Burns)**

Alternate index label for Burns.

### **Bursa Inflammation (Acute And Chronic Bursitis)**

Alternate index label for Acute and Chronic Bursitis.

### **Bursitis Calcific (Calcific Bursitis)**

Alternate index label for Calcific Bursitis.

### **Bursitis Shoulder (Shoulder Bursitis)**

Alternate index label for Shoulder Bursitis.

### **B Virus**

Herpes B virus, also called Macacine alphaherpesvirus 1, a macaque virus that can cause severe and sometimes fatal encephalomyelitis in humans after exposure to infected animals or tissues.

### **B-Type Natriuretic Peptide**

A hormone released mainly by cardiac ventricles in response to increased wall stretch; blood BNP or NT-proBNP levels help evaluate suspected heart failure.

### **B.I.D. (On Prescription)**

An abbreviation from the Latin bis in die meaning twice a day; medication instructions should specify times clearly to avoid dosing errors.

### **Ba**

The chemical symbol for barium, a metal used in compounds such as barium sulfate for contrast studies of the digestive tract.

### **Babinski Response**

Extension of the great toe and fanning of the other toes when the sole is stimulated; it is normal in infants but may indicate corticospinal-tract dysfunction in older children or adults.

### **Baby Blues**

A common, short-lived period of tearfulness, irritability, anxiety, or mood lability during the first days after childbirth, usually resolving within about two weeks.

### **Bacillophobia**

An excessive fear of bacteria or germs; it may lead to avoidance, repeated cleaning, or other anxiety-driven behaviors.

### **Bacterial**

Relating to bacteria, single-celled microorganisms that may be harmless, beneficial, or capable of causing infection.

### **Bar Graph**

A chart that represents values with rectangular bars whose lengths or heights correspond to the quantities being compared.

### **Barber Itch**

An inflammatory infection of hair follicles in the beard area, often caused by bacteria or dermatophyte fungi and associated with itchy bumps or pustules.

### **Barber Say Syndrome**

A rare congenital disorder characterized by excess, lax facial skin, distinctive facial features, sparse hair and eyelashes, and eyelid abnormalities such as ectropion.



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## **Bariatrics**

The branch of medicine concerned with the prevention and treatment of obesity and its associated diseases, including lifestyle, medication, and bariatric surgery.

## **Basal Temperature**

The body's resting temperature, measured immediately after waking and before activity; a sustained small rise can occur after ovulation.

## **Basilar**

Relating to or located at the base of a structure, such as the base of the skull or the basilar artery.

## **Bathophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of depths, such as deep water, wells, or other very deep spaces.

## **Bayes Theorem**

A rule for updating the probability of a condition after new evidence, using the prior probability and the likelihood of that evidence in people with and without the condition.

## **BCC**

Basal cell carcinoma, the most common skin cancer, usually arising on sun-exposed skin and growing slowly with rare distant spread.

## **BCG**

Bacillus Calmette-Guérin, a live attenuated mycobacterial vaccine used against tuberculosis and, when placed in the bladder, as immunotherapy for selected bladder cancers.

## **BCM**

Body cell mass, the metabolically active portion of body mass, including cells of muscle, organs, blood, and other living tissues.

## **Beijerinck, Martinus W.**

A Dutch microbiologist who helped establish the concept of viruses as infectious agents that reproduce only in living cells and contributed to the

development of enrichment culture methods.

## **Bekam**

A Malay name for cupping, a practice in which cups create suction on the skin; wet cupping may also involve superficial skin incisions.

## **Belladonna**

*Atropa belladonna*, the deadly nightshade plant, whose tropane alkaloids such as atropine and scopolamine can cause anticholinergic poisoning.

## **Belly**

The abdomen, the region of the body between the chest and pelvis containing much of the digestive, urinary, and reproductive organs.

## **Benign Melanoma**

A nonstandard or contradictory phrase: melanoma is a malignant melanocytic tumor, so a benign pigmented lesion should generally be described by its specific benign diagnosis rather than as benign melanoma.

## **BER**

Base excision repair, a DNA-repair pathway that removes damaged individual bases and replaces the resulting nucleotide gap.

## **Beta Blocker**

A drug that blocks beta-adrenergic receptors, lowering sympathetic effects such as heart rate and contractility; beta blockers are used for conditions including hypertension, angina, arrhythmias, and heart failure.

## **Beta Cell**

An endocrine cell in the pancreatic islets that produces and releases insulin in response to increased blood glucose.

## **Beta-Agonist**

A drug that stimulates beta-adrenergic receptors; beta-2 agonists relax airway smooth muscle and are used as bronchodilators.

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**BF**

Physician's shorthand for Black female; demographic abbreviations should be used cautiously and replaced with precise, patient-preferred language when possible.

**Bi-**

A prefix meaning two, twice, or involving two sides or components.

**Bias**

A systematic deviation that distorts a measurement, study result, clinical judgment, or decision away from the truth or from an intended fair comparison.

**Bicornuate**

Having two horn-shaped cavities or projections; a bicornuate uterus is a congenital uterine anomaly with two partially separated upper cavities.

**Biermer's Anemia**

Pernicious anemia, a vitamin B12-deficiency anemia caused by impaired absorption, usually because autoimmune loss of intrinsic factor prevents normal B12 uptake.

**Big Toe Sign**

Upward extension of the great toe, often with fanning of the other toes, when the sole is stimulated; in adults it may indicate corticospinal-tract disease.

**Bilateral Pneumonia**

Pneumonia involving both lungs; severity ranges from limited infection to diffuse respiratory failure depending on the cause and host factors.

**Biliary Decompression**

Drainage of obstructed bile ducts, using methods such as endoscopic stenting, nasobiliary drainage, or percutaneous catheter drainage, to restore bile flow.

**Biliary Sand**

Fine particulate material or thick sludge in bile, usually composed of cholesterol crystals, calcium salts,

and pigment, which can contribute to gallstones or duct obstruction.

**Bilious**

Containing or relating to bile; bilious vomiting is typically yellow-green because bile has entered the stomach contents.

**Biliousness**

An older nonspecific term for nausea, indigestion, or vomiting thought to be associated with bile or liver and gallbladder dysfunction.

**Bio-**

A combining form meaning life or living organisms.

**Bioactive**

Having an effect on living cells, tissues, or organisms, such as a bioactive drug, hormone, nutrient, or signaling molecule.

**Biochemical**

Relating to the chemical substances and reactions that occur in living organisms, including metabolism and cellular signaling.

**Biofluid**

A fluid produced by or present in a living organism, such as blood, urine, saliva, cerebrospinal fluid, or synovial fluid.

**Biosafety**

The practices, equipment, and containment procedures used to prevent accidental exposure to or release of biological agents and toxins.

**Biotherapy**

Treatment that uses living organisms, cells, genes, or biological substances to prevent or treat disease; immunotherapy is one form of biotherapy.

**Birth Defect**

A structural, functional, or biochemical abnormality present at birth, caused by genetic, environmental, developmental, or often unknown factors.

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### **Birthmark**

A localized skin or vascular mark present at birth or appearing soon afterward, such as a nevus, hemangioma, or port-wine stain.

### **Bis In Die (On Prescription)**

Latin for twice a day, traditionally abbreviated b.i.d.; medication directions should state the intended dosing times clearly.

### **BKA**

Below-knee amputation, surgical removal of the lower leg while preserving the knee joint.

### **Bladder**

A hollow muscular organ that stores urine received from the kidneys and expels it through the urethra during urination.

### **Bladder Outlet Obstruction (BOO)**

Blockage or narrowing at the bladder neck or urethra that restricts urine flow and can cause hesitancy, weak stream, retention, hydronephrosis, or kidney injury.

### **BLAST**

An immature blood-forming cell, also called a blast; an increased blast percentage in blood or bone marrow can indicate an acute leukemia.

### **Blasts**

Immature precursor cells in the blood-forming tissues; excess blasts may be seen in acute leukemia or other marrow disorders.

### **Bleb**

A thin-walled, blister-like structure, generally larger than 5 mm and containing fluid or air; a fluid-filled bleb is also called a bulla.

### **Blind**

Having severe or complete loss of vision that substantially limits visual function; the degree and cause of visual impairment should be specified.

### **Blood Blister**

A raised, fluid-filled blister containing blood, usually caused by friction, pinching, pressure, or other injury that damages small blood vessels.

### **Blood Cleaner**

A pathogen-inactivation process for donated blood components that uses chemicals, light, or other methods to reduce infectious microorganisms while preserving the blood product.

### **Blood Draw**

Collection of blood, usually by inserting a needle into a vein, for laboratory testing, donation, or other medical use.

### **Blood Group, ABO**

The blood-group system defined by A and B antigens on red blood cells and corresponding antibodies in plasma, producing type A, B, AB, or O.

### **Blood In The Eye**

Bleeding within or around the eye, such as a subconjunctival hemorrhage on the eye surface or a hyphema in the front chamber; the location and cause determine urgency.

### **Blood In The Urine**

Hematuria, the presence of red blood cells or blood products in urine; it may be visible or detected only by urinalysis and requires evaluation for urinary-tract causes.

### **Blood PH**

A measure of blood acidity or alkalinity, regulated mainly by the lungs and kidneys; normal arterial blood pH is approximately 7.35–7.45.

### **Blue Baby Operation**

A historical term for palliative surgery used to improve oxygenation in an infant with cyanotic congenital heart disease, often by increasing pulmonary blood flow.

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### **Blue Sclera**

A bluish appearance of the normally white outer coat of the eye, often caused by scleral thinning and classically associated with osteogenesis imperfecta.

### **Blush**

Temporary reddening or warmth of the face caused by increased superficial blood flow, which may result from emotion, heat, exertion, substances, or medical conditions.

### **BMI Calculation**

Body mass index calculated as weight in kilograms divided by height in meters squared; it is a population-level screening measure and does not directly measure body fat or determine an individual's health.

### **BMT**

An abbreviation commonly meaning bone marrow transplantation, in which blood-forming stem cells are infused after conditioning to replace or restore marrow function.

### **Board Eligible**

Having completed the training or other requirements of a specialty board and being permitted to apply for its certification examination; it does not mean that certification has been achieved.

### **Body Cell Mass**

The metabolically active component of the body, including the cells of muscle, organs, blood, and other living tissues, excluding extracellular water and stored fat.

### **Body Habitus**

A person's general physical build or body composition, including features such as size, shape, muscle, and fat distribution.

### **Bone Type**

A classification of bones by shape or structure, including long, short, flat, irregular, and sesamoid bones.

### **Bones Of The Arm, Wrist And Hand**

The upper-limb bones: humerus; radius and ulna; eight carpal bones; five metacarpals; and the phalanges of the fingers and thumb.

### **Bones Of The Head**

The skull bones, including the cranial bones that enclose the brain and the facial bones that form the face, nasal cavity, orbit, and jaws.

### **Bones Of The Leg, Ankle And Foot**

The lower-limb bones from the knee downward: tibia and fibula; the ankle's talus and other tarsals; five metatarsals; and the toe phalanges.

### **Bones Of The Skeleton**

The adult human skeleton normally contains 206 named bones, forming the axial skeleton and appendicular skeleton and providing support, protection, movement, mineral storage, and marrow for blood formation.

### **Bones Of The Trunk**

The bones forming the central body framework, chiefly the vertebral column, ribs, and sternum, which support the trunk and protect the spinal cord and thoracic organs.

### **Borborygmus**

A rumbling or gurgling sound produced by movement of gas and fluid through the intestines.

### **Bovine**

Relating to cattle, including substances, diseases, or biological products derived from cattle.

### **Bowel Sounds**

Sounds produced by intestinal contractions and movement of gas and fluid, heard with a stethoscope; their frequency and character may change with gastrointestinal disorders.

### **BP**

Blood pressure, the force exerted by circulating blood against arterial walls, usually reported as

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systolic over diastolic pressure in millimeters of mercury.

### **BPD**

An abbreviation commonly meaning bronchopulmonary dysplasia, chronic lung disease after premature birth; it can also mean borderline personality disorder in psychiatric contexts.

### **Brachy-**

A combining form meaning short or abnormally short.

### **Bradykinetic**

Characterized by abnormally slow movement, often used for the movement slowness seen in Parkinson disease and related disorders.

### **Bradyphrenia**

Slowness of thought and mental processing, which may occur with neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, medication effects, or other conditions.

### **Braille System**

A tactile writing and reading system using patterns of raised dots to represent letters, numbers, punctuation, and symbols for people who are blind or have low vision.

### **Breast Bone**

The sternum, a flat bone in the center of the chest that joins the ribs through costal cartilage and helps protect the heart and lungs.

### **Breast Surgeon**

A surgeon who evaluates and treats breast conditions, including benign disease, breast cancer, and reconstructive or risk-reducing surgical needs.

### **Breathing**

Movement of air into and out of the lungs, enabling oxygen uptake and carbon-dioxide removal through ventilation.

### **Bromism**

Toxicity from prolonged or excessive exposure to bromide compounds, which may cause neurologic, psychiatric, gastrointestinal, or skin symptoms.

### **Bronchopulmonary Segments**

Anatomically distinct subdivisions of a lung lobe, each supplied by a segmental bronchus and pulmonary artery branch and separated from neighboring segments by connective-tissue planes.

### **Brontophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of thunder, often associated with fear of lightning or storms.

### **Bruce Protocol**

A standardized graded treadmill exercise test in which speed and incline increase at set intervals to assess exercise capacity and cardiovascular response.

### **Brunhilde Virus**

A strain of poliovirus type 1 used in research and vaccine studies; poliovirus can invade the nervous system and cause paralytic disease.

### **Brushfield's Spots**

Small gray or white spots arranged around the iris, commonly associated with Down syndrome but also found in some people without it.

### **BSA**

Body surface area, an estimate of the body's external area calculated from height and weight and sometimes used for medication dosing or physiologic assessment.

### **BSL**

Biosafety level, a classification of laboratory containment practices and facilities required for work with biological agents of different risks.

### **Bulbar**

Relating to the medulla oblongata or to functions controlled by its cranial-nerve nuclei, including swallowing, speech, and movements of the tongue and

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palate.

### **Bulbourethral Gland**

One of two small male reproductive glands below the prostate that secrete lubricating, alkaline pre-ejaculate into the urethra.

### **Bulging**

Protruding or swelling outward beyond the usual contour, as in a bulging intervertebral disk or bulging membrane.

### **Bullous**

Characterized by bullae, which are large, raised, fluid-filled blisters; bullous disorders may result from infection, burns, drugs, or autoimmune disease.

### **Bumps**

Raised or palpable areas on the skin or under the skin; the cause may range from folliculitis and cysts to trauma, allergy, infection, or tumors.

### **BUN**

Blood urea nitrogen, the amount of nitrogen in blood from urea produced by protein metabolism; it is influenced by kidney function, hydration, protein intake, and tissue breakdown.

### **Bursopathy**

Disease of a bursa, a fluid-filled sac that reduces friction around joints; bursopathy includes inflammation, infection, bleeding, or degeneration.

### **Burundanga (Hyoscine Hydrobromide)**

A name associated with scopolamine, or hyoscine, an anticholinergic drug that can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, confusion, drowsiness, and memory impairment; exposure can be dangerous.

### **Bx**

A common medical abbreviation for biopsy, the removal of cells or tissue for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Bursae**

Small fluid-filled sacs that reduce friction between moving tissues, such as tendon and bone or skin and bone. Inflammation of a bursa is called bursitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

synovial bursae

### **Benign Adrenal Tumors**

Noncancerous growths of an adrenal gland that may be discovered incidentally or may produce excess hormones.

### **Broken Ankle**

A fracture of one or more bones forming the ankle joint, usually causing pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty bearing weight.

### **Broken Arm**

A fracture of one or more bones of the arm, commonly causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or loss of function.

### **Bird Flu (Avian Influenza)**

Influenza caused by avian influenza viruses, which primarily infect birds but can occasionally infect humans and cause severe respiratory illness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Influenza, Avian

### **B And T Lymphocytes**

B lymphocytes produce antibodies, while T lymphocytes coordinate immune responses or kill infected and abnormal cells; both are adaptive immune cells.

### **Babyhood**

Babyhood is the period of infancy, when rapid growth, brain development, motor skills, feeding, and immune maturation occur.

### **Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG)**

Bacille Calmette-Guérin is a live attenuated mycobacterial vaccine used mainly against tuberculosis and, in some settings, as bladder-cancer immunotherapy.



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### Back-Blows

Back-blows are firm blows between the shoulder blades used as a first-aid maneuver for severe choking in a responsive person.

### Back Pressure

Back pressure is pressure exerted in the reverse direction of flow; in medicine it may result from obstruction in an airway, vessel, duct, or organ.

### Bacteraemia

Bacteraemia is the presence of viable bacteria in the bloodstream; it may be transient or lead to sepsis and infection of distant sites.

### Balint's Syndrome

Balint's syndrome is a neurologic disorder caused by bilateral parietal-occipital injury, characterized by impaired visual attention, reaching under visual guidance, and simultaneous perception.

### Ballistocardiograph

A ballistocardiograph records small body movements produced by cardiac ejection and blood flow; it is a historical method of assessing cardiac function.

### Balneology

Balneology is the study or therapeutic use of mineral waters, baths, and spa treatments; evidence and safety depend on the condition and treatment.

### Balsam

A balsam is a resinous plant-derived substance used in some traditional remedies, fragrances, and topical preparations; it may cause contact allergy.

### Banti's Syndrome

Banti's syndrome is an older term for splenic enlargement with anemia and portal hypertension, often associated with chronic congestive or hepatic disease.

### Barium Meal

A barium meal is an upper-gastrointestinal contrast

study in which swallowed barium outlines the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum on radiographs or fluoroscopy.

### Barlow's Disease

Barlow's disease is an older name for severe vitamin-C deficiency, or scurvy, causing bleeding gums, bruising, poor wound healing, and bone or joint symptoms.

### Baroreceptors

Baroreceptors are stretch-sensitive nerve endings in major arteries that detect blood-pressure changes and help regulate heart rate and vascular tone through reflexes.

### Barr Body

A Barr body is the condensed, inactive X chromosome visible in the nucleus of many cells with more than one X chromosome.

### Barraquer-Simons Disease

Barraquer-Simons disease is acquired partial lipodystrophy with loss of subcutaneous fat from the face and upper body and relative fat accumulation in the lower body.

### Barrett's Oesophagus

Barrett's oesophagus is replacement of normal lower-esophageal lining by specialized intestinal-type epithelium after chronic reflux, increasing the risk of dysplasia and adenocarcinoma.

### Bartholin's Glands

Bartholin's glands are paired glands near the vaginal opening that secrete mucus for lubrication through ducts opening into the vestibule.

### Bartholinitis

Bartholinitis is inflammation or infection of a Bartholin gland, often causing painful swelling or an abscess near the vaginal opening.

### Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR)

Basal metabolic rate is the energy the body uses at

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rest to maintain essential functions such as breathing, circulation, temperature, and cellular activity.

### **Basal Nuclei**

The basal nuclei are deep cerebral structures that help select and regulate movement, habits, learning, and other motor and cognitive functions.

### **Basedow's Disease**

Basedow's disease is Graves disease, an autoimmune disorder in which thyroid-stimulating antibodies cause hyperthyroidism, goiter, and sometimes eye or skin manifestations.

### **Basic First Aid**

Basic first aid is immediate care for illness or injury, including scene safety, emergency activation, bleeding control, resuscitation, choking care, and monitoring until help arrives.

### **Basket Cell**

A basket cell is an inhibitory interneuron that forms synaptic contacts around the cell body or axon initial segment of another neuron.

### **Bath Anoaesthesia**

Bath an(a)esthesia is a historical term for loss of sensation associated with bathing or immersion; the wording is uncommon and its meaning depends on the source.

### **Bather's Itch**

Bather's itch is an itchy rash caused by skin penetration of cercarial larvae released by freshwater or marine snails, usually resolving without systemic illness.

### **Battery**

A battery is a collection of cells or tests used together; in healthcare it may also refer to a power source for an implanted device or to harmful battery ingestion.

### **Bauxite-Workers' Lung**

Bauxite-workers' lung is an occupational pneumo-

coniosis associated with inhalation of bauxite dust, potentially causing chronic airway or interstitial lung disease.

### **Bazin's Disease**

Bazin's disease is erythema induratum, a nodular inflammation of subcutaneous fat on the calves, classically associated with tuberculosis but having other causes.

### **Bdellotomy**

Bdellotomy is the surgical incision or removal of a leech attached to tissue, a historical procedure used to control bleeding or prevent retained mouthparts.

### **Beats, Cardiac**

Cardiac beats are the repeated cycles of atrial and ventricular electrical activation and contraction that propel blood through the circulation.

### **Becker's Muscular Dystrophy**

Becker muscular dystrophy is an X-linked dystrophinopathy causing progressive skeletal-muscle weakness, usually later and more slowly than Duchenne muscular dystrophy.

### **Bedbug**

A bedbug is a blood-feeding *Cimex* insect that causes itchy bites, skin reactions, anxiety, and occasionally secondary infection but is not known to transmit human disease routinely.

### **Bee Stings**

Bee stings inject venom and can cause localized pain and swelling, large local reactions, or life-threatening anaphylaxis in sensitized people.

### **Beer-Drinker's Heart**

Beer-drinker's heart is an older term for alcohol-related dilated cardiomyopathy, in which chronic heavy alcohol use weakens and enlarges the heart.

### **Behçet's Syndrome**

Behçet's syndrome is a relapsing inflammatory disorder causing recurrent oral and genital ulcers, eye

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inflammation, skin lesions, and sometimes vascular, neurologic, or gastrointestinal disease.

### **Bejel**

Bejel is endemic treponematosi, a chronic infection caused by *Treponema pallidum pertenue* or related treponemes and spread mainly by close nonsexual contact in endemic areas.

### **Benedikt's Syndrome**

Benedikt's syndrome is a midbrain lesion causing ipsilateral oculomotor palsy with contralateral tremor, ataxia, or involuntary movements.

### **Benserazide**

Benserazide inhibits peripheral dopa decarboxylase and is combined with levodopa to increase brain delivery and reduce peripheral adverse effects in Parkinson disease.

### **Benzhexol**

Benzhexol, or trihexyphenidyl, is an anticholinergic drug used mainly to reduce tremor and rigidity in Parkinson disease or drug-induced extrapyramidal symptoms.

### **Benzyl Benzoate**

Benzyl benzoate is a topical acaricide and insecticide used for scabies and sometimes lice; skin irritation and careful application are important.

### **Benzylpenicillin**

Benzylpenicillin, or penicillin G, is a beta-lactam antibiotic used for susceptible serious infections, including some streptococcal and syphilis infections.

### **Berkeley's Sign**

Berkeley's sign is an eponym with varying historical use; the exact clinical finding should be confirmed from the source in which it appears.

### **Beta-Adrenoceptor-Blocking Drugs**

Beta-adrenoceptor-blocking drugs reduce beta-adrenergic effects on the heart and other tissues and are used for hypertension, angina, arrhythmias,

heart failure, and other indications.

### **Beta-Haemolytic Streptococcus**

A beta-haemolytic streptococcus completely lyses red cells around colonies on blood agar; important species include group A and group B streptococci.

### **Beta-Human Chorionic Gonadotrophin**

Beta-human chorionic gonadotrophin is the beta subunit of hCG, measured in blood or urine to detect pregnancy and to assess selected tumors or pregnancy problems.

### **Bethanechol**

Bethanechol is a muscarinic cholinergic agonist that stimulates bladder and gastrointestinal smooth muscle, used selectively for urinary retention or impaired motility.

### **Biacetyl**

Biacetyl, or diacetyl, is a diketone compound with a buttery odor used in flavoring and industry; inhalational exposure can injure the small airways.

### **Bicêtre Hospital**

Bicêtre Hospital is a historic hospital in France associated with medical and psychiatric history; the term is institutional rather than a disease or body structure.

### **Biceps**

The biceps is a two-headed muscle, especially the biceps brachii of the upper arm, that flexes the elbow and supinates the forearm.

### **Bichat's Membrane**

Bichat's membrane is an older anatomical term generally referring to a serous or connective-tissue membrane; its exact usage depends on the historical source.

### **Bicipital**

Bicipital means relating to a two-headed muscle, especially the biceps tendon, groove, or muscle of the upper arm.

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## **Bicolor**

Bicolor means having two colors; in medicine it may describe a two-toned lesion, specimen, iris, or other structure and requires context.

## **Biconcave**

Biconcave means concave on both sides; the normal red blood cell is a classic biconcave disc, a shape that supports flexibility and gas exchange.

## **Biconvex**

Biconvex means convex on both sides; the term may describe a lens, implant, or radiologic shape.

## **Bicornuate Uterus**

A bicornuate uterus is a congenital uterine shape with two upper cavities caused by incomplete fusion of the embryonic Müllerian ducts; it may affect pregnancy outcomes.

## **Bicycled Foot**

Bicycled foot is an uncommon descriptive term for a foot deformity or position associated with cycling or repetitive mechanical stress; exact meaning depends on the source.

## **Bifocal**

Bifocal means having two focal points; bifocal spectacles correct near and distance vision, while bifocal imaging or lenses have two optical zones.

## **Bifurcation**

Bifurcation is the division of one structure, vessel, airway, nerve, or pathway into two branches.

## **Bigeminy**

Bigeminy is a cardiac rhythm pattern in which a normal beat alternates regularly with a premature beat, often a premature ventricular contraction.

## **Bile Ducts**

Bile ducts are channels that carry bile from the liver and gallbladder to the duodenum; obstruction can cause jaundice, pain, infection, or pancreatitis.

## **Bile Salts**

Bile salts are bile-derived detergent molecules that emulsify dietary fats and help absorb lipids and fat-soluble vitamins in the intestine.

## **Biliverdin**

Biliverdin is a green bile pigment formed during heme breakdown and normally converted to bilirubin by biliverdin reductase.

## **Billroth's Operation**

Billroth's operations are historical partial gastrectomy procedures, especially Billroth I and II, that reconnect the remaining stomach to the duodenum or jejunum.

## **Bimedial**

Relating to or positioned on the medial side of two structures, or involving both medial aspects; the exact anatomical reference must be specified by the structure being described.

## **Bimellar**

Bimellar means composed of two lamellae or layers, such as a double-layered membrane or tissue structure.

## **Bimanual**

Bimanual means performed with both hands, as in a bimanual pelvic examination or two-handed surgical technique.

## **Binary Fission**

Binary fission is asexual reproduction in which one cell or organism divides into two genetically similar descendants, common among bacteria and protozoa.

## **Biomedical Engineering**

Biomedical engineering applies engineering, materials science, computing, and design to medical devices, diagnostics, prostheses, imaging, and health systems.

## **Biomicroscopy**

Biomicroscopy is microscopic examination of liv-

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ing tissue, especially slit-lamp examination of the eye's cornea, anterior chamber, lens, and related structures.

### **Bionics**

Bionics uses electronic or mechanical systems to reproduce or augment biological functions, such as hearing, movement, or sensory feedback.

### **Biorhythm**

A biorhythm is a recurring biological pattern such as the circadian sleep-wake cycle; popular fixed-cycle theories are not established medical diagnoses.

### **Biostatistics**

Biostatistics applies statistical methods to biomedical data, including study design, estimation, hypothesis testing, epidemiology, and interpretation of clinical evidence.

### **Biosynthesis**

Biosynthesis is the enzyme-directed production of complex molecules by living cells from simpler precursors.

### **Biot's Breathing**

Biot's breathing is an abnormal pattern of irregular breaths interrupted by unpredictable periods of apnea, associated with disruption of respiratory control.

### **Biparental**

Biparental means involving or inherited from both biological parents, as in biparental inheritance or a pregnancy involving genetic contributions from both parents.

### **Biphosphonates**

Biphosphonates are drugs that reduce osteoclast-mediated bone resorption and treat osteoporosis, Paget disease, and some cancer-related bone complications.

### **Bipolar**

Bipolar is a medical term describing the named

concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Bipolar Affective Disorder**

Bipolar affective disorder is a mood disorder with recurrent manic or hypomanic episodes and usually depressive episodes, causing changes in mood, energy, sleep, and function.

### **Birth Pains**

Birth pains are painful uterine contractions and related pressure during labor as the cervix dilates and the baby moves through the birth canal.

### **Bisexual**

Bisexual describes sexual or romantic attraction to more than one gender; it is an identity or orientation, not a disease or disorder.

### **Bistoury**

A bistoury is a small surgical knife, historically used for precise incision or opening of tissue.

### **Bitters**

Bitters are intensely flavored plant preparations traditionally used as digestive remedies; evidence, composition, interactions, and safety vary by product.

### **Bituminosis**

Bituminosis is an occupational lung condition caused by inhalation of bitumen or asphalt fumes and dust, potentially producing airway irritation or chronic respiratory disease.

### **Biuret Test**

The biuret test detects peptide bonds by producing a violet color with proteins in alkaline copper solution; it is a laboratory chemistry test.

### **Bivalve**

Bivalve means having two shells or valves; bivalve mollusks may be relevant to food allergy, poisoning, or parasitic exposure.

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## **Black Death**

The Black Death was the historic pandemic of plague, primarily caused by *Yersinia pestis*, with severe mortality in the fourteenth century.

## **Blackflesh**

Blackflesh is a descriptive term for dark or blackened tissue, potentially reflecting bruising, necrosis, gangrene, pigmentation, or contamination; clinical examination determines the cause.

## **Black Fly**

A black fly is a biting Simuliidae insect that can cause local reactions and, in endemic regions, transmit *Onchocerca volvulus*.

## **Black Hair, Hairy Tongue**

Black hairy tongue is benign elongation and discoloration of the tongue's filiform papillae, associated with smoking, antibiotics, poor oral hygiene, and some foods or medicines.

## **Blackhead**

A blackhead is an open comedone in which sebum and keratin plug a hair follicle and darken at the surface through oxidation.

## **Black Lung Disease**

Black lung disease is coal workers' pneumoconiosis caused by inhaled coal dust, ranging from simple nodules to progressive massive fibrosis and respiratory impairment.

## **Bladder, Diseases Of**

Diseases of the bladder include infection, inflammation, stones, obstruction, neurogenic dysfunction, bleeding, and tumors, often causing urinary or pelvic symptoms.

## **Bladder, Urinary**

The urinary bladder is a muscular reservoir that stores urine and contracts to expel it through the urethra.

## **Bleeder's Disease**

Bleeder's disease is an older name for hemophilia, an inherited clotting-factor deficiency causing prolonged or recurrent bleeding.

## **Blind Spot**

A blind spot is an area of absent vision, especially the optic-disc region where the optic nerve exits the retina and photoreceptors are absent.

## **Bloated**

Bloated describes a feeling or appearance of abdominal fullness, pressure, or enlargement, commonly caused by gas, constipation, diet, or gastrointestinal disease.

## **Block**

A block is obstruction or interruption of flow, conduction, movement, or communication, such as an airway block, nerve block, or heart block.

## **Blocking Agents**

Blocking agents inhibit a receptor, enzyme, ion channel, nerve signal, or physiologic pathway; their effects and risks depend on the target and drug.

## **Blood Brain Barrier**

The blood-brain barrier is a selective system of brain capillary cells and supporting structures that limits movement of substances from blood into nervous tissue.

## **Blood Count**

A blood count measures numbers and characteristics of red cells, white cells, and platelets to assess anemia, infection, inflammation, marrow disease, and bleeding risk.

## **Blood Gas Analysis**

Blood gas analysis measures oxygen, carbon dioxide, pH, and related values to assess ventilation, oxygenation, and acid-base status.

## **Blood Groups**

Blood groups classify inherited red-cell antigens,



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such as ABO and Rh, to guide compatible transfusion, pregnancy care, and transplantation.

### **Blood Plasma**

Blood plasma is the liquid component of blood containing water, electrolytes, proteins, nutrients, hormones, gases, and waste products.

### **Blood Poisoning**

Blood poisoning is a nontechnical term usually referring to sepsis or bloodstream infection, a potentially life-threatening dysregulated response to infection.

### **Blood Results**

Blood results are laboratory measurements from a blood sample, interpreted using the test method, reference interval, symptoms, and clinical context.

### **Blood Test**

A blood test analyzes blood cells, chemicals, proteins, hormones, antibodies, genes, or other markers to investigate health or disease.

### **Blue Bottle**

Blue bottle is a common name for several organisms or objects; in medical contexts it may refer to a bluebottle jellyfish whose sting causes pain and skin inflammation.

### **Blue-Green Algae**

Blue-green algae are cyanobacteria; some produce toxins that can contaminate water or food and cause gastrointestinal, neurologic, liver, or skin illness.

### **Blue Nævus**

A blue naevus is a usually benign melanocytic skin lesion containing pigment deep in the dermis, giving it a blue or blue-black appearance.

### **Blushing**

Blushing is temporary facial redness caused by increased cutaneous blood flow, triggered by emotion, heat, exertion, hormones, medicines, or some diseases.

### **BMR**

BMR is basal metabolic rate, the energy the body expends at rest to maintain essential functions.

### **Board-Like Rigidity**

Board-like rigidity is marked involuntary abdominal-wall stiffness, classically suggesting peritoneal irritation and a possible surgical abdomen.

### **Boas' Sign**

Boas' sign is referred pain or skin hypersensitivity below the right shoulder blade described in association with gallbladder disease; it is not sufficiently specific alone for diagnosis.

### **Bobbing, Ocular**

Ocular bobbing is a rapid downward movement of both eyes followed by a slower return, a sign of severe pontine or other neurologic dysfunction.

### **Bock's Disease**

Bock's disease is an older name for sarcoidosis, a granulomatous inflammatory disorder that can affect the lungs, lymph nodes, skin, eyes, and other organs.

### **Body**

The body is the physical organism and its integrated systems, tissues, organs, and functions; medical assessment considers structure, physiology, and health together.

### **Body Fat**

Body fat is adipose tissue that stores energy, cushions organs, insulates the body, and produces endocrine signals; excess or insufficient amounts affect health.

### **Body Fluids**

Body fluids include blood, lymph, cerebrospinal fluid, urine, synovial fluid, and other water-based compartments that transport substances and support physiology.

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### **Body Mass Index (BMI)**

BMI is weight in kilograms divided by height in meters squared; it screens population-level weight categories but does not directly measure body fat or individual health.

### **Body Odour**

Body odour is smell produced when skin secretions are metabolized by microorganisms; changes may reflect hygiene, diet, medicines, infection, or metabolic disease.

### **Boerhaave's Syndrome**

Boerhaave's syndrome is spontaneous full-thickness rupture of the esophagus, usually after forceful vomiting, causing severe chest pain, infection, and mediastinal contamination.

### **Bogros' Space**

Bogros' space is a preperitoneal anatomical plane behind the inguinal region used as a surgical dissection plane in hernia repair.

### **Bojlen's Syndrome**

Bojlen's syndrome is an uncommon historical eponym whose usage varies; the original clinical definition should be verified from the source.

### **Bombay Blood Group**

The Bombay blood group is a rare phenotype lacking the H antigen, causing apparent type O blood that can receive red cells only from compatible Bombay-type donors.

### **Bombe**

Bombe is a historical term used in medical and biological naming; its precise meaning depends on the organism, apparatus, or source in which it appears.

### **Bone Conduction**

Bone conduction transmits sound through skull vibration to the inner ear, bypassing the outer and middle ear; testing helps distinguish conductive from sensorineural hearing loss.

### **Bone-Marrow Transplantation**

Bone-marrow transplantation replaces diseased or damaged marrow with hematopoietic stem cells, either from the patient or a donor.

### **Bongkrek Poisoning**

Bongkrek poisoning is severe food poisoning from bongkrekin acid produced by contaminated fermented foods, causing mitochondrial energy failure and potentially fatal liver or neurologic injury.

### **Bonnevie-Ullrich Syndrome**

Bonnevie-Ullrich syndrome is a historical name for features associated with Turner syndrome, including short stature, webbed neck, gonadal dysfunction, and characteristic physical findings.

### **Borna Disease**

Borna disease is an uncommon neurologic infection caused by Borna disease virus, primarily recognized in animals and rarely considered in humans.

### **Botfly**

A botfly is a fly whose larvae can infest animal or human tissue, causing furuncular or wound myiasis.

### **Bothriocephalus**

Bothriocephalus is a historical or taxonomic tapeworm genus; related fish tapeworm infections may cause abdominal symptoms or vitamin-B12 deficiency.

### **Bowel Cancer**

Bowel cancer is malignant growth in the colon or rectum, commonly causing altered bowel habit, bleeding, anemia, weight loss, or abdominal symptoms.

### **Bowel, Diseases Of**

Diseases of the bowel include infection, inflammation, obstruction, malabsorption, functional disorders, bleeding, and tumors affecting the small or large intestine.

### **Bowman's Capsule**

Bowman's capsule is the cup-shaped beginning of a

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nephron that surrounds the glomerulus and collects the filtrate produced from blood.

### **Boxer's Ear**

Boxer's ear is deformity of the outer ear caused by repeated trauma, usually involving cartilage thickening, scarring, or a cauliflower-ear appearance.

### **Boxer's Fracture**

A boxer's fracture is a fracture of the neck of the fifth metacarpal, commonly caused by punching, producing hand pain, swelling, and altered knuckle contour.

### **Brachial**

Brachial means relating to the upper arm, especially its bones, vessels, or nerves.

### **Brachialgia**

Brachialgia is pain radiating along the arm, often from cervical nerve-root irritation or brachial plexus disease.

### **Brachium**

The brachium is the anatomical upper arm between the shoulder and elbow.

### **Brachycephalic**

Brachycephalic means having a relatively short, broad skull; it may describe normal variation or a craniofacial pattern in a genetic condition.

### **Bradypnoea**

Bradypnoea is abnormally slow breathing, which may result from medicines, neurologic disease, metabolic disturbance, or severe illness.

### **Brain Haemorrhage**

Brain haemorrhage is bleeding within or around the brain, caused by trauma, hypertension, vascular lesions, clotting problems, or other disease.

### **Brain Malformations**

Brain malformations are structural abnormalities of the brain that develop before birth. They may result

from genetic factors, disrupted fetal development, infection, or other prenatal influences and can affect neurologic function.

### **Brain Sand**

Brain sand is an older name for corpora arenacea, tiny calcified deposits commonly found in the pineal gland and sometimes other brain regions.

### **Brain Tumour**

A brain tumour is an abnormal growth in or near the brain, which may be benign or malignant and can cause seizures, headache, cognitive change, or focal deficits.

### **Bramwell's Disease**

Bramwell's disease is an older eponym with variable usage, historically associated with cardiac or circulatory disease; the source context is required for precision.

### **Branchial**

Branchial means relating to embryonic gill-arch structures or their derivatives in the head and neck.

### **Brass-Founder's Ague**

Brass-founder's ague is metal-fume fever, an influenza-like illness after inhalation of fumes from heated metals such as zinc or brass.

### **Breast Development**

Breast development is growth and maturation of mammary tissue during puberty, pregnancy, lactation, and hormonal life stages.

### **Breath**

Breath is air moved into and out of the lungs; its odor, volume, pattern, and gas composition can provide clinical information.

### **Breathalyzer**

A breathalyzer estimates blood alcohol concentration by measuring alcohol in exhaled air; results can be affected by device, timing, and sampling conditions.

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## Breathing Exercises

Breathing exercises deliberately change respiratory pattern to improve ventilation, relaxation, airway clearance, breath control, or rehabilitation.

## Breathlessness

Breathlessness is the subjective sensation of difficult or uncomfortable breathing, caused by pulmonary, cardiac, metabolic, neuromuscular, or psychological conditions.

## Bregma

Bregma is the skull landmark where the coronal and sagittal sutures meet; in infants it corresponds to the anterior fontanelle.

## Brenner Tumour

A Brenner tumour is usually a benign ovarian epithelial tumor with transitional-cell-like nests; rare borderline and malignant forms occur.

## Breslau Bacillus

Breslau bacillus is an older name for *Salmonella enterica* serovar Typhimurium, a bacterium associated with gastroenteritis and foodborne disease.

## Bricklayer's Disease

Bricklayer's disease is an occupational lung condition historically associated with inhalation of silica-containing dust, potentially causing silicosis.

## Bridge Work

Bridge work is a fixed dental prosthesis that replaces one or more missing teeth by attaching artificial teeth to adjacent teeth or implants.

## Brill-Zinsser Disease

Brill-Zinsser disease is reactivation of latent epidemic typhus years after the original infection, causing a usually milder typhus-like illness.

## Brine Bath

A brine bath is immersion in salty water, used recreationally or therapeutically; benefits and risks depend on skin condition, temperature, and patient

health.

## Brittle Bone Disease

Brittle bone disease is osteogenesis imperfecta, an inherited connective-tissue disorder causing fragile bones, recurrent fractures, and variable hearing, dental, or skeletal findings.

## Brodie's Abscess

Brodie's abscess is a localized, usually subacute form of bone infection, often in the metaphysis of a long bone, causing persistent pain and a cavity in bone.

## Bromides

Bromides are salts or compounds containing bromide; prolonged or excessive exposure can cause bromism with neurologic, psychiatric, gastrointestinal, or skin symptoms.

## Bromodosis

Bromodosis is unusually offensive foot odor caused by sweat, moisture, and bacterial or fungal breakdown of skin debris.

## Bronchial Asthma

Bronchial asthma is a chronic inflammatory airway disorder with variable, usually reversible bronchoconstriction, wheeze, cough, chest tightness, and breathlessness.

## Bronchioles

Bronchioles are small branching airways that conduct air from the bronchi toward the alveoli and regulate airflow through smooth muscle.

## Bronchocele

Bronchocele is an abnormal dilation or mucus-filled expansion of a bronchus, often related to obstruction or congenital airway abnormality.

## Brooke Disease

Brooke disease is a rare inherited skin disorder historically associated with widespread keratinization or follicular abnormalities; the precise eponym re-

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quires source context.

### Brooke-Spiegler Syndrome

An inherited skin-tumor syndrome, usually caused by pathogenic variants in *CYLD*, characterized by multiple benign adnexal tumors including trichoepitheliomas, cylindromas, and spiradenomas.

### Brown-Séguard Syndrome

Brown-Séguard syndrome follows hemisection or asymmetric injury of the spinal cord, causing ipsilateral weakness and loss of vibration with contralateral pain and temperature loss below the lesion.

### Brown Teeth

Brown teeth are teeth with brown discoloration from staining, decay, developmental enamel defects, fluorosis, medicines, trauma, or other causes.

### Bruch's Membrane

Bruch's membrane is a thin extracellular matrix layer between the retinal pigment epithelium and choroid that supports retinal metabolism and transport.

### Bruck's Syndrome

Bruck syndrome is a rare inherited disorder combining bone fragility resembling osteogenesis imperfecta with congenital joint contractures.

### Brugia

*Brugia* is a filarial nematode genus that includes parasites causing lymphatic filariasis, transmitted by mosquitoes.

### Brunner's Glands

Brunner's glands are mucus- and bicarbonate-secreting glands in the duodenum that help protect the intestinal lining from gastric acid.

### Brush Burns

Brush burns are superficial friction burns caused by scraping skin against a rough surface, producing pain, redness, and abrasions.

### Bryant's Traction

Bryant's traction is a historical traction technique for treating selected pediatric femoral fractures or hip conditions by elevating the child's legs; it is used cautiously.

### Bubonic Plague

Bubonic plague is infection with *Yersinia pestis* causing painful swollen lymph nodes, fever, and systemic illness, usually after a flea bite.

### Buccal

Buccal means relating to the cheek or the inner cheek surface; buccal medicines are placed between cheek and gum for absorption.

### Buccinator

The buccinator is a cheek muscle that compresses the cheek and assists chewing, sucking, blowing, and speech.

### Buchanan's Disease

Buchanan's disease is a historical eponym with inconsistent usage; its intended diagnosis must be established from the original clinical source.

### Buffalo Hump

A buffalo hump is a pad of fat at the back of the neck and upper back, associated with obesity, corticosteroid excess, HIV therapy, or Cushing syndrome.

### Bulbar Palsy

Bulbar palsy is weakness or paralysis of muscles supplied by lower cranial nerves, causing dysarthria, dysphagia, impaired gag, and difficulty handling secretions.

### Bulbocavernosus

Bulbocavernosus is a medical term describing the named concept; its precise interpretation depends on its defining features, associated findings, and clinical context.

### Bulbospongiosus

Bulbospongiosus is the paired perineal muscle that

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helps empty the urethra and contributes to erection and expulsion of genital secretions.

### **Bullet Wounds**

Bullet wounds are penetrating or perforating injuries caused by firearm projectiles, potentially damaging skin, organs, vessels, nerves, and bone.

### **Bunionplasty**

Bunionplasty is surgery to correct a bunion or hallux valgus deformity, often by realigning bone and balancing surrounding soft tissues.

### **Burnout**

Burnout is occupational exhaustion, mental distancing or cynicism, and reduced professional efficacy caused by chronic workplace stress; it is distinct from a medical diagnosis of depression.

### **Burnt-Out Joint**

A burnt-out joint is an older description of a joint in which active inflammatory disease has subsided but permanent structural damage and restricted movement remain.

### **Burroughs**

Burroughs is a surname or eponym used inconsistently in medical sources; the associated condition or person must be identified from context.

### **Buttock**

The buttock is the rounded posterior region overlying the gluteal muscles, used for movement, sitting, examination, and selected injections.

### **Buttonhole Deformity**

Buttonhole deformity is a finger deformity with flexion of the proximal interphalangeal joint and hyperextension of the distal interphalangeal joint, often due to central slip injury or rheumatoid disease.

### **Buttressing**

Buttressing is reinforcement or thickening that supports a weakened structure; in bone it may describe

cortical stress adaptation or surgical structural support.

### **Butylamine**

Butylamine is an irritating industrial amine whose vapor or liquid can injure the eyes, skin, and respiratory tract after exposure.

### **Butyric Acid**

Butyric acid is a short-chain fatty acid produced by gut bacteria during fiber fermentation and used by colon cells as an energy source; concentrated exposure irritates tissue.

### **By-Pass**

A by-pass is a route created around an obstruction, such as a vascular, gastrointestinal, or urinary surgical bypass, or a cardiac bypass circuit.

### **Bridge To Transplant**

Temporary mechanical circulatory support used to maintain a patient with advanced heart failure until heart transplantation can be performed. The device and duration depend on ventricular function, organ status, complications, and transplant eligibility.

### **Blaschko Lines**

Invisible developmental skin-cell lines that may become visible when certain congenital or acquired dermatoses follow their characteristic linear or whorled patterns. They do not usually correspond to nerves or blood vessels.

### **Blood Banking**

The collection, testing, processing, storage, and distribution of blood and blood components for transfusion.

### **Blood-Borne Pathogens**

Infectious microorganisms transmitted through blood or certain body fluids, including viruses such as HIV and hepatitis B and C; prevention requires appropriate barrier precautions and safe handling of sharps.



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### **Breakthrough Infection**

An infection that occurs after a person has received a vaccine or other preventive intervention intended to reduce that infection; severity and protection vary by pathogen, product, and host factors.

### **Bilateral Gynecomastia**

Enlargement of breast glandular tissue affecting both breasts in a male patient; causes include hormonal imbalance, medicines, obesity, liver or kidney disease, and rarely malignancy.

### **Brachioplasty**

An operation, commonly called an arm lift, that removes or reshapes excess skin and tissue of the upper arm; risks include scarring, sensory change, fluid collection, and wound complications.

### **Breast Cytology**

Cytologic evaluation of breast lesions using fine-needle aspiration, nipple discharge, or other samples. It can help distinguish benign, suspicious, and malignant processes but may require core biopsy for definitive classification.

### **Bethesda System For Reporting Thyroid Cytopathology**

A six-tier standardized system for reporting thyroid fine-needle aspiration results, from nondiagnostic and benign categories to follicular-pattern, suspicious, and malignant categories; each tier guides risk assessment and management.

### **Benign CNS Cyst**

A non-neoplastic fluid-filled lesion within or around the central nervous system, such as an arachnoid, epidermoid, or colloid cyst. Clinical significance depends on location, size, growth, and obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid pathways.

### **Bartholin Gland Hyperplasia**

Enlargement and proliferation of Bartholin gland tissue, which may present as a vulvar mass and can mimic a cyst or neoplasm; persistent or atypical lesions require clinical assessment and biopsy.

### **Benign Mullerian Papilloma**

A rare benign papillary lesion of the vulvovaginal region showing Müllerian-type epithelial differentiation, usually presenting as a small polypoid lesion.

### **Bartholin Gland Mucinous Cyst**

A mucus-filled cyst arising from obstruction of a Bartholin gland duct, usually presenting as a fluctuant mass in the posterolateral vaginal introitus; infection may produce an abscess.

### **Bizarre Parosteal Osteochondromatous Proliferation**

A rare benign but locally recurrent bone-surface lesion, also called Nora Lesion, composed of cartilage, bone, and spindle cells; it most often affects the hands or feet.

### **Bone And Mineral Disorders**

Conditions affecting bone strength, mineralization, calcium-phosphate balance, or skeletal remodeling, including osteoporosis, osteomalacia, hyperparathyroidism, and inherited metabolic bone disease.



## C

### C-Peptide

A peptide released in equimolar amounts with endogenous insulin when proinsulin is cleaved. Measurement helps estimate endogenous beta-cell insulin secretion and distinguish endogenous from injected insulin, with interpretation affected by renal function and glucose level.

### C. Diff

Alternate index label; see *C. difficile infection*.

### C. Difficile Colitis

Alternate index label; see *Pseudomembranous colitis*.

### Cancer Of Unknown Origin

Alternate index label; see *Carcinoma of unknown primary*.

### Cancer, Carcinoid Tumors

Alternate index label; see *Carcinoid tumors*.

### Cancer, Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia

Alternate index label; see *Chronic lymphocytic leukemia*.

### Cancer, Chronic Myelogenous Leukemia

Alternate index label; see *Chronic myelogenous leukemia*.

### Cancer, Colon

Alternate index label; see *Colon cancer*.

### Cancer, Endometrial

Alternate index label; see *Endometrial cancer*.

### Cancer, Esophageal

Alternate index label; see *Esophageal cancer*.

### Cancer, Eye Melanoma

Alternate index label; see *Eye melanoma*.

### Cancer, Floor Of The Mouth

Alternate index label; see *Floor of the mouth cancer*.

### Cancer, Gallbladder

Alternate index label; see *Gallbladder cancer*.

### Cancer, Gastric

Alternate index label; see *Stomach cancer*.

### Cancer, Hairy Cell Leukemia

Alternate index label; see *Hairy cell leukemia*.

### Cancer, Hodgkin Lymphoma

Alternate index label; see *Hodgkin lymphoma (Hodgkin disease)*.

### Cancer, Hurthle Cell

Alternate index label; see *Hurthle cell cancer*.

### Cancer, Inflammatory Breast

Alternate index label; see *Inflammatory breast cancer*.

### Cancer, Kidney

Alternate index label; see *Kidney cancer*.

### Cancer, Liver

Alternate index label; see *Liver cancer*.

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**Cancer, Lung**

Alternate index label; see *Lung cancer*.

**Cancer, Merkel Cell**

Alternate index label; see *Merkel cell carcinoma*.

**Cancer, Mouth**

Alternate index label; see *Mouth cancer*.

**Cancer, Multiple Myeloma**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple myeloma*.

**Cancer, Nasopharyngeal**

Alternate index label; see *Nasopharyngeal carcinoma*.

**Cancer, Neuroblastoma**

Alternate index label; see *Neuroblastoma*.

**Cancer, Neuroendocrine**

Alternate index label; see *Neuroendocrine tumors*.

**Cancer, Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma**

Alternate index label; see *Non-Hodgkin lymphoma*.

**Cancer, Ovarian**

Alternate index label; see *Ovarian cancer*.

**Cancer, Pancreatic**

Alternate index label; see *Pancreatic cancer*.

**Cancer, Paraneoplastic Syndromes**

Alternate index label; see *Paraneoplastic syndromes of the nervous system*.

**Cancer, Prostate**

Alternate index label; see *Prostate cancer*.

**Cancer, Rectal**

Alternate index label; see *Rectal cancer*.

**Cancer, Retinoblastoma**

Alternate index label; see *Retinoblastoma*.

**Cancer, Skin**

Alternate index label; see *Skin cancer*.

**Cancer, Soft Tissue Sarcoma**

Alternate index label; see *Soft tissue sarcoma*.

**Cancer, Squamous Cell**

Alternate index label; see *Squamous cell carcinoma of the skin*.

**Cancer, Stomach**

Alternate index label; see *Stomach cancer*.

**Cancer, Testicular**

Alternate index label; see *Testicular cancer*.

**Cancer, Throat**

Alternate index label; see *Throat cancer*.

**Cancer, Thyroid**

Alternate index label; see *Thyroid cancer*.

**Cancer, Uterine**

Alternate index label; see *Endometrial cancer*.

**Cancer, Vagina**

Alternate index label; see *Vaginal cancer*.

**Cancer, Vulvar**

Alternate index label; see *Vulvar cancer*.

**Cancer, Wilms' Tumor**

Alternate index label; see *Wilms tumor*.

**Candidiasis, Oral**

Alternate index label; see *Oral thrush*.

**Candidiasis, Vaginal**

Alternate index label; see *Yeast infection (vaginal)*.

**Carbuncles And Boils**

Alternate index label; see *Boils and carbuncles*.

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**Cardiac Arrest, Sudden**

Alternate index label; see *Sudden cardiac arrest*.

**Cardiac Ischemia**

Alternate index label; see *Myocardial ischemia*.

**Cardiomyopathy, Dilated**

Alternate index label; see *Dilated cardiomyopathy*.

**Cardiomyopathy, Hypertrophic**

Alternate index label; see *Hypertrophic cardiomyopathy*.

**Carotid Arteries**

Major paired arteries in the neck supplying blood to the brain, neck, and face; common site for atherosclerotic plaque formation and stenosis.

**Carotid Artery Stenosis**

Narrowing of one or both carotid arteries, usually from atherosclerotic plaque, which can reduce blood flow to the brain or release emboli and cause a transient ischemic attack or stroke. It is often asymptomatic until severe and is evaluated with vascular imaging, commonly carotid ultrasound.

**Carotid Insufficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Carotid artery disease*.

**CAS**

Alternate index label; see *Childhood apraxia of speech*.

**Central Neurofibromatosis**

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

**Cercarial Dermatitis**

Alternate index label; see *Swimmer's itch*.

**Cerebral Embolism**

Alternate index label; see *Embolic stroke (brain embolism)*.

**Cervical Osteoarthritis**

Alternate index label; see *Cervical spondylosis*.

**Cervical Pain**

Alternate index label; see *Neck pain*.

**CF**

Alternate index label; see *Cystic fibrosis*.

**CHD**

Alternate index label; see *Hip dysplasia*.

**Chemical Dependency**

Alternate index label; see *Drug addiction (substance use disorder)*.

**Chest Wall Pain**

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.

**Child Maltreatment**

Alternate index label; see *Child abuse*.

**Cholangitis, Primary Sclerosing**

Alternate index label; see *Primary sclerosing cholangitis (PSC)*.

**Chorea, Huntington's**

Alternate index label; see *Huntington's disease*.

**Chronic Acid Reflux**

Alternate index label; see *Gastroesophageal reflux disease (GERD)*.

**Chronic Adrenal Insufficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Addison's disease*.

**Chronic Compartment Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic exertional compartment syndrome*.

**Chronic Kidney Failure**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic kidney disease*.

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**Chronic Lymphocytic Thyroiditis**

Alternate index label; see *Hashimoto's disease*.

**Chronic Renal Failure**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic kidney disease*.

**Chronic Vulvar Pain**

Alternate index label; see *Vulvodynia*.

**CJD**

Alternate index label; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease*.

**Click-Murmur Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Mitral valve prolapse*.

**Clinic Visit**

Scheduled outpatient appointment for medical consultation, follow-up, or monitoring of a chronic condition.

**CLL**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic lymphocytic leukemia*.

**Cold Allergy**

Alternate index label; see *Cold urticaria*.

**Cold Exposure**

Alternate index label; see *Hypothermia*.

**Cold, Common**

Alternate index label; see *Common cold*.

**Colitis, Ischemic**

Alternate index label; see *Ischemic colitis*.

**Colitis, Microscopic**

Alternate index label; see *Microscopic colitis*.

**Colitis, Pseudomembranous**

Alternate index label; see *Pseudomembranous colitis*.

**Colitis, Ulcerative**

Alternate index label; see *Ulcerative colitis*.

**Collapsed Arch**

Alternate index label; see *Flatfeet*.

**Columnar Epithelium Lined Lower Esophagus**

Alternate index label; see *Barrett's esophagus*.

**Complicated Bereavement**

Alternate index label; see *Complicated grief*.

**Compressed Nerve**

Alternate index label; see *Pinched nerve*.

**Compulsive Overeating**

Alternate index label; see *Binge-eating disorder*.

**Compulsive Stealing**

Alternate index label; see *Kleptomania*.

**Condylomata Acuminata**

Alternate index label; see *Genital warts*.

**Congenital Biliary Atresia**

Alternate index label; see *Biliary atresia*.

**Congenital Plagiocephaly**

Alternate index label; see *Craniosynostosis*.

**Conversion Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *Functional neurologic disorder/conversion disorder*.

**Cooley's Anemia**

Alternate index label; see *Thalassemia*.

**Coronary Microvascular Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Small vessel disease*.

**Costosternal Chondrodynia**

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.



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## Costosternal Syndrome

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.

## COVID-19

Coronavirus disease caused by infection with SARS-CoV-2. Illness ranges from asymptomatic or mild disease to pneumonia, respiratory failure, thrombosis, or death; common symptoms include fever, cough, shortness of breath, fatigue, muscle aches, and altered taste or smell. Some people develop persistent symptoms after the acute infection.

## Crabs

Alternate index label; see *Pubic lice (crabs)*.

## Cramp, Muscle

Alternate index label; see *Muscle cramp*.

## Cramps, Menstrual

Alternate index label; see *Menstrual cramps*.

## Crib Death

Alternate index label; see *Sudden infant death syndrome (SIDS)*.

## Crossmatch

Laboratory test mixing donor and recipient blood to detect preformed antibodies that could cause transfusion or transplant reactions.

## Cyst, Bartholin's

Alternate index label; see *Bartholin's cyst*.

## Cyst, Ganglion

Alternate index label; see *Ganglion cyst*.

## Cyst, Kidney

Alternate index label; see *Kidney cysts*.

## Cyst, Ovarian

Alternate index label; see *Ovarian cysts*.

## Cyst, Pancreatic

Alternate index label; see *Pancreatic cysts*.

## Cyst, Pilonidal

Alternate index label; see *Pilonidal cyst*.

## Cyst, Spermatic

Alternate index label; see *Spermatocele*.

## Cystitis, Interstitial

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial cystitis*.

## Cysts, Epidermoid

Alternate index label; see *Epidermoid cysts*.

## Cysts, Sebaceous

Alternate index label; see *Epidermoid cysts*.

## C-Reactive Protein

An acute-phase reactant produced by the liver in response to inflammation (IL-6). CRP rises within 4-6 hours of inflammatory stimulus and peaks at 36-50 hours. Uses: monitoring inflammatory disease activity (RA, vasculitis), detecting infection post-operatively, and cardiovascular risk stratification (hs-CRP: high-sensitivity).

## C-Section

Cesarean section, surgical delivery of a fetus through incisions in the abdominal wall and uterus.

## C. Difficile

*Clostridioides difficile*, a gram-positive, spore-forming bacterium that causes antibiotic-associated diarrhea and colitis. *C. difficile* produces toxins A and B that cause colonic inflammation. Risk factors include antibiotic exposure, proton pump inhibitor use, and advanced age. Treatment includes vancomycin or fidaxomicin.

## C282Y Mutation

Most common genetic cause of hereditary hemochromatosis, a C to T transition in the HFE gene resulting in cysteine to tyrosine substitution at position 282. Homozygosity occurs in approximately one in two hundred individuals of Northern European descent.

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## CA 19-9

A blood marker that may be elevated in pancreatic and other gastrointestinal cancers as well as in benign biliary or inflammatory conditions. It is not sufficiently specific for cancer screening or diagnosis by itself.

## CA-125

A blood marker used mainly to assess some ovarian cancers and to monitor selected patients. It can also rise in benign gynecologic, inflammatory, liver, and other malignant conditions, so it is not sufficient by itself to screen for or diagnose ovarian cancer.

## CA125

Cancer Antigen 125, a protein tumor marker used primarily in the evaluation of ovarian cancer.

## CABG (Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting)

Open heart surgery to bypass stenotic coronary arteries using autologous grafts. On-pump: cardiopulmonary bypass, cardioplegic arrest. Off-pump (OPCAB): beating heart, no bypass machine.

### Synonyms:

Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting

## Cabot Ring

A threadlike or ring-shaped inclusion in a red blood cell, sometimes seen in severe anemia or disorders of erythropoiesis. It represents residual nuclear material or mitotic spindle remnants.

## Cachexia

A multifactorial syndrome of involuntary weight loss, skeletal-muscle wasting, and systemic inflammation associated with chronic diseases such as cancer, heart failure, COPD, and advanced kidney disease.

## Cacosmia

A distorted or unpleasant perception of smell, in which odors may seem foul or disagreeable. It can occur with sinonasal disease, infection, seizures, trauma, or other neurologic disorders.

## Cadaver

A dead human body used for anatomical dissection, surgical training, and medical research. Cadavers are preserved through embalming (arterial injection of formaldehyde-based fixatives) to prevent decomposition and maintain tissue integrity.

## Cadaveric Spasm

Rare form of instantaneous post-mortem stiffening of a specific group of voluntary muscles at the exact moment of death, without an intervening period of muscle relaxation.

## Caecitis

Inflammation of the cecum. Causes include infection, inflammatory bowel disease, ischemia, neutropenic enterocolitis, and extension of adjacent inflammatory disease.

## Caecopexy

Surgical fixation of the cecum to the abdominal wall or retroperitoneum, performed to prevent or treat abnormal cecal mobility or recurrent cecal volvulus.

## Caecostomy

Surgical creation of an opening from the cecum to the abdominal wall for decompression or diversion of intestinal contents. It may be temporary or part of treatment for selected distal obstruction.

## Caecotomy

Surgical incision into the cecum, usually to remove a foreign body, access the bowel, or facilitate another abdominal procedure.

## Caesarean Birth

An operative procedure in which a baby is delivered through an incision in the abdominal wall and uterus. Indications: fetal distress, failure to progress in labor, breech presentation, placenta praevia, multiple pregnancy, previous cesarean, and maternal request.

## Cafe-Au-Lait Macules

Flat, uniformly hyperpigmented, light-brown to

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dark-brown (café-au-lait, "coffee with milk") macules, > 5 mm in prepubertal children or > 15 mm in postpubertal individuals.

### Caffeine

A naturally occurring xanthine alkaloid and central nervous system stimulant found in coffee, tea, chocolate, and many soft drinks and energy beverages. Mechanism: adenosine receptor antagonist (primarily A1 and A2A subtypes), increasing neuronal activity and promoting catecholamine release.

### Caffeine Withdrawal

A syndrome occurring after abrupt cessation or reduction of caffeine use. Symptoms include headache, fatigue, depressed mood, difficulty concentrating, and flu-like symptoms. Onset is typically 12–24 hours after last caffeine intake, peak at 20–51 hours, and duration of 2–9 days.

### Café Au Lait Spot

A flat, sharply demarcated, light-brown skin macule caused by increased melanin. Multiple lesions may be a feature of neurofibromatosis type 1 or other genetic disorders.

### Caisson Disease

Decompression sickness caused by formation of inert-gas bubbles after a rapid reduction in ambient pressure. It can cause joint pain, neurologic injury, respiratory symptoms, or circulatory collapse.

### Calcaneus

Largest tarsal bone forming the heel. Articulates with talus proximally and cuboid anteriorly. Lever for the calf muscles via the Achilles tendon on its posterior tuberosity. Predominantly trabecular bone, the most commonly fractured tarsal bone from falls from height. Bohler's angle assesses fractures on lateral radiographs.

### Calciferol

Vitamin D is a fat-soluble vitamin (actually a prohormone) essential for calcium and phosphorus homeostasis and bone health. See Vitamin D: Calcitriol.

### Calcific Uremic Arteriopathy

A rare disorder, usually associated with advanced kidney disease, in which small blood vessels calcify and cause painful skin and soft-tissue injury or necrosis.

### Calcification

Calcification is abnormal deposition of calcium salts in tissue; its significance depends on the site, pattern, underlying injury, and associated disease. Calcium or phosphate metabolism is abnormal.

### Calcinosis

Cutaneous calcinosis, the deposition of insoluble calcium phosphate salts within the skin and subcutaneous tissues, occurring in connective tissue diseases such as scleroderma and dermatomyositis, or as a localized phenomenon. Lesions present as firm, white, subcutaneous nodules that may ulcerate and extrude chalky material.

### Calcinosis

The pathological deposition of calcium salts in cutaneous and subcutaneous tissues, presenting as firm, white to yellowish nodules or plaques that may ulcerate and extrude chalky material.

### Calciphylaxis

Calcific uremic arteriopathy causing painful skin necrosis in CKD. Risk factors include warfarin use, elevated calcium-phosphorus product, and obesity. High mortality rate. Treat with sodium thiosulfate, wound care, and discontinuation of warfarin. Avoid calcium-based binders.

### Calcitonin

A 32-amino-acid peptide hormone secreted by the parafollicular C-cells of the thyroid gland in response to elevated serum calcium. It lowers blood calcium by inhibiting osteoclast-mediated bone resorption and increasing renal calcium excretion.

### Calcitriol And Analogues

Active vitamin D forms suppressing PTH. Calcitriol, paricalcitol, doxercalciferol. Monitor calcium and phosphorus to avoid hypercalcemia and hyperphos-

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phatemia. Part of CKD-MBD management.

## Calcium

A mineral and intracellular second messenger required for bone mineralization, muscle contraction, neurotransmitter release, blood coagulation, and enzyme regulation. Plasma calcium is present as ionized, protein-bound, and complexed fractions.

## Calcium Blood Test

Measurement of calcium in the blood, usually reported as total calcium and interpreted with albumin; ionized calcium may be measured directly when the biologically active fraction is needed. It helps evaluate parathyroid disorders, bone disease, kidney disease, and abnormal calcium levels.

## Calcium Channel Blocker Overdose

Toxic exposure to a calcium-channel blocker that may cause low blood pressure, slow heart rate, conduction abnormalities, high blood glucose, or shock. It requires urgent medical and poison-control management.

## Calcium Channel Blockers

Agents that block L-type calcium channels, reducing calcium influx into cardiac and smooth muscle cells. Dihydropyridines (amlodipine, nifedipine) cause vasodilation and are used for hypertension and angina.

## Calcium Phosphate

The principal mineral constituent of bone and teeth, existing as hydroxyapatite crystals. In pathological states, calcium phosphate deposits form in soft tissues through dystrophic calcification in damaged tissue or metastatic calcification in hypercalcemic conditions.

## Calcium Pyrophosphate Arthritis

Acute or chronic inflammatory arthritis caused by deposition of calcium pyrophosphate crystals in cartilage and joints. Acute attacks, often called pseudogout, commonly affect the knee or wrist and are diagnosed by identifying weakly positively birefringent crystals in synovial fluid.

## Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition Disease

A crystal arthropathy caused by deposition of calcium pyrophosphate dihydrate crystals in articular cartilage (chondrocalcinosis). Presents with acute pseudogout (most common): acute monoarticular inflammation of the knee or wrist, mimicking gout but less painful.

### Synonyms:

Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition

## Calcium Sensing Receptor

G-protein coupled receptor expressed primarily on parathyroid glands and renal tubular cells that senses extracellular ionized calcium levels. On parathyroid glands activation suppresses PTH secretion. On renal tubular cells activation increases calcium excretion and decreases phosphate reabsorption.

## Calcium Stones

Most common kidney stone type composed of calcium oxalate or calcium phosphate. Risk factors include hypercalciuria, hyperoxaluria, hypocitraturia, and low urine volume. Treat with thiazides for hypercalciuria, dietary modification, and hydration. Potassium citrate for hypocitraturia.

## Calculus (Tartar)

Mineralized dental plaque. Cannot be removed by brushing. Requires professional scaling. Retains plaque, promotes inflammation.

### Synonyms:

Tartar

## Calculus Removal

Professional cleaning to remove hardened plaque. Scaling and root planing. Ultrasonic and hand instruments.

## Caldwell-Luc Operation

A surgical approach to the maxillary sinus through the canine fossa of the anterior maxilla. It is used selectively for access to maxillary sinus disease, lesions, or foreign bodies.

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## Caloric Restriction

Reduced calorie intake without malnutrition. Associated with longevity, reduced chronic disease risk. Requires careful planning.

## Calorie

A unit of energy measurement used in nutrition to quantify the energy content of foods and energy expenditure of the body. One kilocalorie (kcal, commonly called a Calorie with capital C) equals the energy required to raise 1 kilogram of water by 1 degree Celsius.

### Synonyms:

a Calorie.

## Cambridge Classification

ERCP-based grading system for chronic pancreatitis severity evaluating the main pancreatic duct, branches, and common bile duct. Normal pancreas shows smooth duct without abnormalities. Equivocal shows fewer than three abnormal side branches. Mild shows three or more abnormal side branches. Moderate shows abnormal main duct.

## Cameron Lesions

Linear gastric erosions or ulcers found on the mucosal folds at the diaphragmatic hiatus in patients with large hiatal hernias. They result from mechanical trauma as the gastric mucosa prolapses through the diaphragmatic crura during respiration and movement.

## Campimetry

Measurement and mapping of the visual field, usually by presenting stimuli at different locations while the patient maintains fixation. It helps detect and characterize defects from retinal, optic-nerve, or retrochiasmal disease.

## Camptocormia

A marked forward flexion of the trunk that increases while standing or walking and improves when lying down. It can occur with axial myopathy, Parkinsonian disorders, dystonia, or other neuromuscular disease.

## Camptodactyly

A congenital or acquired flexion deformity of one or more fingers, usually caused by shortening or abnormality of tendons, muscles, fascia, or joints. It often affects the proximal interphalangeal joints.

## Campylobacter Infection

Bacterial gastroenteritis caused most often by *Campylobacter jejuni* or *C. coli*, usually acquired from contaminated poultry, food, water, or unpasteurized milk. It causes fever, abdominal cramps, and diarrhea that may be bloody and can rarely precede Guillain-Barre syndrome.

## Campylobacteriosis

Infection caused by *Campylobacter* species, commonly producing fever, abdominal pain, and inflammatory diarrhea that may be bloody. Complications can include dehydration, bacteremia, reactive arthritis, or Guillain-Barré syndrome.

## Canal Of Schlemm

A circular endothelial-lined channel at the corneoscleral junction that drains aqueous humor from the anterior chamber into the episcleral venous circulation. Impaired outflow contributes to glaucoma.

## Canalith Repositioning Maneuver

A series of head movements used to move displaced inner-ear crystals out of a semicircular canal, commonly to treat posterior-canal benign positional vertigo.

## Canavan Disease

An autosomal-recessive leukodystrophy caused by aspartoacylase deficiency, leading to accumulation of N-acetylaspartate and progressive spongy degeneration of cerebral white matter. It typically presents in infancy with hypotonia followed by developmental impairment and macrocephaly.

## Cancer

Cancer is uncontrolled growth of abnormal cells that can invade nearby tissue and spread to distant organs; behavior and treatment depend on its tissue of origin and molecular features. or spread to

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distant sites. Cancer may arise in any tissue and is classified by its site and cell type. Early detection and treatment improve outcomes.

### **Cancer Care Team**

The multidisciplinary group of health professionals involved in cancer care, which may include oncologists, surgeons, radiologists, pathologists, nurses, pharmacists, rehabilitation specialists, psychologists, and palliative-care professionals.

### **Cancer Cell**

A cell that has acquired genetic and epigenetic abnormalities allowing uncontrolled growth, impaired normal differentiation, resistance to cell death, invasion of surrounding tissues, or spread to distant sites.

### **Cancer Genetics**

Inherited cancer syndromes. Examples: BRCA1/2 (breast, ovarian), Lynch syndrome (colon), Li-Fraumeni (various).

### **Cancer Nutrition**

Malnutrition common in cancer. Hypermetabolism, cachexia, treatment side effects. Nutritional support improves outcomes. High protein, high calorie.

### **Cancer Of Unknown Primary**

Metastatic cancer in which the primary site cannot be identified despite investigation. Workup includes histology, immunohistochemistry, and molecular profiling to guide treatment.

### **Cancer Pain**

Pain caused by a tumor, its spread, or cancer treatment. It may be continuous or episodic and can involve bone, nerves, or internal organs. Management may include treating the cancer, non-opioid medicines, opioids, nerve-directed treatments, and supportive care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain Cancer (Cancer Pain)

### **Cancer Registry**

System for collecting cancer data. Used for epidemiology, quality improvement, research.

### **Cancer Screening**

Testing people without symptoms to detect certain cancers or precancerous changes early, when treatment may be more effective.

### **Cancer Staging**

Classification of cancer extent. TNM system: T (tumor size/extent), N (nodal involvement), M (metastasis). Stages: 0 (in situ), I (early), II-III (advanced), IV (metastatic). Guides treatment and prognosis.

### **Cancer Surveillance**

The systematic, ongoing collection and analysis of information about cancer incidence, stage, treatment, survival, recurrence, and mortality for patient follow-up, research, and public-health planning.

### **Cancer Survivor**

Person living with cancer from diagnosis through end of life and beyond.

### **Cancer Susceptibility Genes**

Genes in which inherited pathogenic variants increase a person's risk of developing one or more cancers. Examples include BRCA1, BRCA2, APC, and mismatch-repair genes; a susceptibility variant does not guarantee that cancer will develop.

### **Cancer Vaccine**

A vaccine intended either to prevent cancer-causing infections or to stimulate an immune response against cancer cells. Preventive examples target oncogenic infections, while therapeutic vaccines are designed for selected established cancers.

### **Cancer-Associated Thrombosis**

Venous or arterial thrombosis occurring in the setting of active malignancy or its treatment. Tumor biology, immobilization, surgery, central venous devices, and systemic therapy contribute to risk; anti-



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coagulation is individualized according to bleeding risk and cancer factors.

### **Cancrum Oris**

Noma, a rapidly destructive gangrenous infection of the mouth and face that occurs mainly in severely malnourished or immunocompromised children. It begins with gingival or mucosal necrosis and can extend through facial tissues.

### **Candida Albicans Infection**

Infection caused by the yeast *Candida albicans*, ranging from mucosal disease to invasive bloodstream or organ infection in vulnerable patients.

### **Candida Auris**

A multidrug-resistant yeast that can colonize skin and cause invasive bloodstream, wound, or ear infections, especially in hospitalized or immunocompromised patients. It spreads readily in healthcare settings and requires laboratory identification and strict infection-control measures.

### **Candidal Intertrigo**

A *Candida* infection of skin folds (axillae, inframammary, inguinal, intergluteal, pannus) characterized by erythematous, macerated plaques with satellite pustules at the periphery. Most common in obese, diabetic, and immunocompromised patients, and with prolonged antibiotic use. Presents with itching, burning, and soreness.

### **Candidemia**

The presence of *Candida* species in the bloodstream. It is an invasive fungal infection associated with intravascular devices, surgery, intensive care, immunosuppression, and substantial risk of organ dissemination.

### **Candidiasis**

Fungal infection caused by *Candida* species, most commonly *C. albicans*. Mucocutaneous: oral thrush (white plaques on oral mucosa), esophagitis, vulvovaginitis (itching, discharge), and intertrigo. Invasive candidiasis: candidemia and deep organ infection, typically in immunocompromised or ICU

patients. Diagnosis: culture, histopathology.

### **Cane**

Walking aid for balance. Types: quad (four-base), single-point. Held on opposite side of injury.

### **Canicola Fever**

A form of leptospirosis associated particularly with *Leptospira interrogans* serovar canicola. It may cause fever, headache, myalgia, conjunctival suffusion, and renal or hepatic involvement.

### **Canker Sore**

A common aphthous ulcer of the oral mucosa, appearing as a painful, shallow, round or oval ulcer with an erythematous border. Most heal spontaneously, but recurrent, severe, or atypical ulcers require assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Recurrent Oral Ulcers Ulcer, Aphthous

### **Cannabis Use Disorder**

A problematic pattern of cannabis use leading to significant impairment. Criteria include tolerance and withdrawal (irritability, anger, decreased appetite, restlessness, anxiety, sleep disturbance). Cannabis intoxication includes euphoria, impaired judgment, and time distortion.

### **Cannot Intubate Cannot Oxygenate**

The most critical airway emergency — inability to intubate the trachea and inability to oxygenate the patient by face mask or supraglottic airway despite optimal efforts. CICO is a life-threatening situation requiring immediate surgical airway access. Signs: SpO<sub>2</sub> decreasing despite 100% O<sub>2</sub>, absent end-tidal CO<sub>2</sub>, no chest rise.

### **Cannulation**

The insertion of a cannula into a blood vessel, body cavity, duct, or other anatomical passage to permit drainage, infusion, monitoring, sampling, or access for a procedure.

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### **Cantlie Line**

Functional liver division extending from the gallbladder fossa to the IVC, corresponding to the middle hepatic vein plane. Unlike the falciform ligament (anatomical division), it represents the true functional blood supply/biliary drainage division. Right hepatic artery and portal vein supply the right half; left supply the left.

### **Capacity**

Autonomous voluntary authorization given by a competent patient to undergo a specific medical intervention, procedure, or clinical trial. See informed consent.

### **Capacity And Competence**

Decision-making capacity is a clinical evaluation performed by a physician to determine whether a patient understands the nature, consequences, risks, and alternatives of a specific proposed medical decision at a given time.

### **Capgras Syndrome**

A delusional misidentification syndrome in which a person believes that someone familiar has been replaced by an identical impostor. It can occur in neurodegenerative disease, psychosis, brain injury, or other neurologic conditions.

### **Capillaroscopy**

Examination of the small vessels in the nail-fold or another accessible surface using magnification. It can reveal capillary dilation, hemorrhage, avascular areas, and abnormal architecture in connective-tissue and microvascular disease.

### **Capillary**

The smallest blood vessel in the body, forming a microscopic network (capillary bed) that connects arterioles to venules.

### **Capillary Bed**

A network of interconnected capillaries that links arterioles to venules within a tissue. It provides a large surface area for exchange of oxygen, carbon dioxide, nutrients, hormones, and metabolic waste

between blood and interstitial fluid.

### **Capillary Leak Syndrome**

A disorder of increased capillary permeability in which plasma and proteins move from the intravascular space into surrounding tissues. It may cause hypotension, haemoconcentration, hypoalbuminaemia, oedema, and shock; causes include severe infection, immune-mediated disease, toxins, and rare idiopathic episodes.

### **Capillary Refill**

A bedside assessment of peripheral perfusion performed by briefly pressing a nail bed or skin and measuring the time for normal color to return. Delayed refill may indicate poor circulation, shock, hypothermia, or vascular disease.

### **Capillary Refill Time**

The time required for color to return after pressure briefly blanches a nail bed or area of skin. A delayed result may suggest impaired peripheral perfusion, but interpretation depends on age, temperature, technique, and the clinical setting.

### **Capitate**

Largest carpal bone, centrally located in the distal row as the carpal keystone. Rounded head articulates with scaphoid and lunate; distal surface with the third metacarpal. Last carpal bone to ossify. Wrist joint axis, bearing significant axial load. Avascular necrosis may occur with fractures similar to scaphoid injuries.

### **Capnocytophaga Canimorsus**

A Gram-negative, capnophilic bacillus found in the oral flora of dogs and cats that causes severe sepsis, meningitis, and cellulitis in humans, particularly the immunocompromised, asplenic, or elderly. Infection typically follows dog or cat bites. It is a fastidious organism requiring prolonged incubation for culture.

### **Capnography**

Continuous measurement and graphical display of exhaled carbon dioxide during anesthesia and sedation. The waveform and end-tidal value help

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assess ventilation, airway patency, circulation, and confirmation of tracheal tube placement.

### **Capsular Contracture**

Abnormal tightening and hardening of the fibrous capsule around an implanted device, especially a breast implant. It may cause pain, distortion, firmness, or displacement.

### **Capsule Endoscopy**

Non-invasive diagnostic technique using a swallowable wireless endoscopic device to capture images of the small intestinal mucosa. The capsule contains a miniature video camera and transmitter that sends images to a receiver worn on the patient's belt.

### **Capsule Of Glisson**

The connective-tissue capsule surrounding the liver, which sends fibrous septa inward along portal tracts and supports the organ's vessels, ducts, and nerves.

### **Capsule Of Tenon**

A fascial sheath surrounding the globe of the eye and separating it from orbital fat. It contributes to eye movement and forms a potential space used in some ophthalmic procedures.

### **Capsulectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of a fibrous capsule surrounding an organ, implant, or other structure. The indication depends on contracture, infection, pathology, or the need to revise a reconstruction.

### **Caput Medusae**

Dilated periumbilical veins radiating outward from the umbilicus, seen in portal hypertension with recanalization of the umbilical vein. Not strictly a cardiac finding but relevant in right heart failure causing hepatic congestion and portal hypertension. It must be distinguished from caval collateral circulation.

### **Caput Succedaneum**

Edema of the scalp presenting as a soft, boggy swelling that crosses suture lines. Caused by pres-

sure of the vaginal walls on the fetal head during labor. Resolves within hours to days. Differentiated from cephalohematoma (subperiosteal, does not cross suture lines) and subgaleal hemorrhage (life-threatening, crosses suture lines).

### **CAR T-Cell**

Chimeric antigen receptor T-cells. Engineered immune cells targeting cancer.

### **Carbapenem-Resistant Enterobacteriaceae Infection**

Infection caused by Enterobacteriaceae bacteria resistant to carbapenem antibiotics, often involving the urinary tract, lungs, bloodstream, or wounds. These infections are difficult to treat and may spread in healthcare settings. Culture and susceptibility testing guide therapy, with strict infection-control measures needed to prevent transmission.

### **Carbapenem-Resistant Organisms**

Bacteria that are resistant to carbapenem antibiotics, typically through production of carbapenemases. The most important carbapenemases include KPC (Klebsiella pneumoniae carbapenemase), NDM (New Delhi metallo-beta-lactamase), and OXA-48-like enzymes. CRO are a major public health threat due to limited treatment options.

### **Carbidopa**

A peripheral dopa decarboxylase inhibitor that does not cross the blood-brain barrier; combined with levodopa to prevent its peripheral conversion to dopamine, reducing side effects (nausea, hypotension) and increasing CNS levodopa delivery.

### **Carbohydrate**

A class of organic compounds composed of carbon, hydrogen, and oxygen (general formula  $C_m(H_2O)_n$ ), serving as the primary energy source for the body.

### **Carbohydrate Counting**

Method for diabetes management. Matching insulin to carbohydrate intake. Education essential.

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## Carbolic Acid (Phenol)

An aromatic organic compound (C<sub>6</sub>H<sub>5</sub>OH) with antiseptic, disinfectant, and caustic properties. Historically significant as the first surgical antiseptic introduced by Joseph Lister in 1867, dramatically reducing post-operative infection and mortality. Mechanism: denatures bacterial proteins and disrupts cell membranes.

### Synonyms:

Phenol

## Carbon Dioxide Absorber

A safety device used in anesthesia breathing circuits that filters out carbon dioxide from a patient's exhaled breath, allowing the remaining anesthetic gases to be safely recycled and rebreathed.

## Carbon Dioxide Transport

The movement of CO<sub>2</sub> from tissues to lungs. CO<sub>2</sub> is carried in blood in three forms: dissolved (approximately 10 percent), bound to hemoglobin as carbamino compounds (approximately 20 percent), and as bicarbonate (approximately 70 percent).

## Carbon Ion Therapy

Radiation using carbon ions. Higher biological effectiveness. Limited availability.

## Carbon Monoxide Poisoning

Inhibits hemoglobin oxygen binding (affinity 200x oxygen). Causes headache, dizziness, nausea, cherry-red skin, syncope, death. Diagnosis: carboxyhemoglobin level (not routine). Treatment: 100% oxygen, hyperbaric oxygen if severe (neurological symptoms, COHb >25%, pregnancy).

## Carbonic Anhydrase Inhibitors

Medicines that inhibit carbonic anhydrase and reduce formation of aqueous humor. They are used mainly to lower intraocular pressure and, in some circumstances, to treat edema or metabolic disorders.

## Carboxyhemoglobin

Toxicity from inhalation of carbon monoxide (CO),

a colorless, odorless gas binding hemoglobin 200-300 times more avidly than oxygen, forming carboxyhemoglobin (COHb) and reducing oxygen delivery. See carbon monoxide poisoning.

## Carbuncle

A cluster of interconnected furuncles caused most often by *Staphylococcus aureus*, producing a painful inflamed swelling with multiple draining points and sometimes fever; diabetes increases risk.

## Carcinogen

Substance causing cancer. Types: chemical (benzene, asbestos, aflatoxin), physical (radiation), biological (HPV, HBV, HCV). Mechanisms: DNA damage, mutations, epigenetic changes. IARC classifications: Group 1 (carcinogenic), Group 2A (probably carcinogenic), Group 2B (possibly carcinogenic), Group 3 (not classifiable).

## Carcinoid Heart Disease

Cardiac complication of carcinoid syndrome occurring in approximately fifty percent of patients with hepatic metastases. Serotonin and other vasoactive substances bypass hepatic metabolism and cause endocardial fibrosis affecting the right-sided heart valves particularly the tricuspid and pulmonary valves.

## Carcinoid Syndrome

Serotonin-secreting neuroendocrine tumor causing flushing, diarrhea, bronchospasm, and right-sided heart disease. Occurs when vasoactive substances bypass hepatic metabolism through venous drainage or liver metastases. Diagnosis is with twenty-four hour urine 5-hydroxyindoleacetic acid or serum chromogranin A.

## Carcinoid Tumor

Carcinoid tumors are well-differentiated neuroendocrine neoplasms that arise from enterochromaffin cells throughout the gastrointestinal tract and bronchial system. The most common primary sites are the appendix, small intestine, and rectum.

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## **Carcinoma**

Malignant tumor of epithelial origin. Types: squamous cell carcinoma, adenocarcinoma, basal cell carcinoma, transitional cell carcinoma. Most common cancer type (80-90% of malignancies). Examples: lung carcinoma, breast carcinoma, colon carcinoma.

## **Carcinoma En Cuirasse**

An unusual form of breast cancer characterized by diffuse, firm, indurated skin that resembles armor. It results from extensive dermal lymphatic invasion by tumor cells.

## **Carcinoma In Situ**

Full-thickness dysplasia without invasion through basement membrane. Stage 0 cancer.

## **Carcinosarcoma**

A malignant tumor containing both carcinomatous and sarcomatous elements, most commonly of the uterus (malignant mixed Müllerian tumor), with an aggressive course.

## **Cardiac Allograft**

A donor heart transplanted into a recipient with end-stage heart failure. The procedure requires lifelong immunosuppression to prevent rejection. Complications include rejection, cardiac allograft vasculopathy, infection, and malignancy; monitored by endomyocardial biopsy and echocardiography.

## **Cardiac Amyloidosis**

Deposition of amyloid protein in the heart, causing stiff ventricular walls, impaired filling, arrhythmias, or heart failure. Important types include immunoglobulin light-chain (AL) and transthyretin (ATTR) amyloidosis; treatment depends on the type and organ involvement.

## **Cardiac Amyloidosis Diagnosis**

Diagnosis involves a combination of clinical suspicion, imaging, and tissue biopsy. Non-invasive diagnosis using Tc-99m pyrophosphate (PYP) or DPD scintigraphy for ATTR cardiac amyloidosis (with negative serum/urine free light chains to exclude AL amyloidosis).

## **Cardiac Amyloidosis Staging**

Mayo Clinic staging system for ATTR cardiac amyloidosis: Stage I (NT-proBNP <3000 pg/mL), Stage II (NT-proBNP 3000-8499), Stage III (NT-proBNP ≥8500). Median survival: Stage I: 69 months, Stage II: 47 months, Stage III: 14 months. Treatment with tafamidis (TTR stabilizer) improves survival and functional capacity.

## **Cardiac Arrest**

Sudden loss of effective heart pumping, causing unresponsiveness, absent normal breathing, and no detectable pulse. Initial rhythms may be shockable or nonshockable; treatment requires immediate cardiopulmonary resuscitation, defibrillation when indicated, and advanced resuscitation care.

## **Cardiac Arrest Survival**

Outcome after cardiac arrest depends on the cause, location, initial rhythm, time to CPR and defibrillation, and post-arrest care. Early recognition, high-quality CPR, rapid defibrillation when indicated, advanced life support, and appropriate post-arrest treatment improve the chance of survival.

## **Cardiac Axis**

The mean direction of ventricular depolarization in the frontal plane, estimated from the QRS complex on a 12-lead ECG. Left or right axis deviation may reflect conduction disease, ventricular hypertrophy, infarction, or altered cardiac position.

## **Cardiac Biomarkers**

Blood measurements used to assess myocardial injury. Cardiac troponins I and T are the preferred specific biomarkers; CK-MB may assist in selected situations, while myoglobin is sensitive but nonspecific. Results must be interpreted with symptoms, electrocardiography, and serial testing.

## **Cardiac Catheterization**

Invasive procedure involving insertion of catheters into the heart via peripheral arteries or veins. Diagnostic catheterization measures intracardiac pressures, saturations, and performs coronary angiography. Indications include evaluation of CAD, valvu-



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lar disease, cardiomyopathy, and congenital heart disease.

### **Cardiac Imaging Tests**

Noninvasive or minimally invasive studies used to evaluate cardiac structure, function, blood flow, or tissue characteristics. They include echocardiography, cardiac CT, cardiac MRI, nuclear perfusion imaging, and other modality-specific tests selected according to the clinical question.

### **Cardiac Radionuclide Imaging**

Cardiac imaging performed after administration of a radioactive tracer, usually with SPECT or PET, to assess myocardial perfusion, viability, metabolism, or inflammation. ECG-gated studies can also estimate ventricular volumes and ejection fraction; results must be interpreted with symptoms and other cardiac tests.

### **Cardiac Conduction System**

The specialized tissue responsible for generating and conducting electrical impulses through the heart. Components include the sinoatrial (SA) node, internodal pathways, atrioventricular (AV) node, bundle of His, right and left bundle branches, and Purkinje fibers.

### **Cardiac CT**

CT imaging of heart and coronary arteries. Coronary calcium scoring, coronary CT angiography, cardiac function assessment.

### **Cardiac CT Angiography**

Noninvasive imaging using CT to visualize coronary arteries and cardiac structures. It has high negative predictive value for excluding coronary artery disease, making it useful for low-to-intermediate risk patients with chest pain. Calcium scoring quantifies coronary artery calcification as a marker of atherosclerosis.

### **Cardiac Cycle**

The sequence of events occurring during one complete heartbeat, consisting of systole (contraction) and diastole (relaxation). During diastole, the ven-

tricles fill with blood; during systole, they contract and eject blood.

### **Cardiac Defibrillation**

Delivery of an unsynchronized electrical shock for ventricular fibrillation or pulseless ventricular tachycardia. It is combined with high-quality CPR and advanced life support according to the cardiac-arrest rhythm and protocol.

### **Cardiac Device Infections**

Infection involving a pacemaker, implantable defibrillator, generator pocket, or lead. Findings may include local inflammation, drainage, bacteremia, or endocarditis. Evaluation uses clinical examination, blood cultures, and imaging when indicated; treatment may require antimicrobial therapy and removal of infected hardware.

### **Cardiac Diet**

A dietary pattern emphasizing vegetables, fruits, whole grains, legumes, fish, unsaturated fats, and limited sodium, added sugars, and saturated or trans fats. It supports cardiovascular risk reduction but should be individualized for heart failure, kidney disease, diabetes, and nutritional adequacy.

### **Cardiac Gated SPECT**

SPECT imaging synchronized with ECG. Assess ventricular function, wall motion, viability.

### **Cardiac Index**

Cardiac output normalized to body surface area (BSA), calculated as  $CO / BSA$ . Normal cardiac index is 2.5–4.2 L/min/m<sup>2</sup>. It provides a more accurate assessment of cardiac function than cardiac output alone, accounting for body size. A cardiac index below 2.2 L/min/m<sup>2</sup> indicates cardiogenic shock.

### **Cardiac Metastases**

More common than primary cardiac tumors. Most frequent sources: lung cancer, breast cancer, melanoma, lymphoma, and renal cell carcinoma. Most commonly involve the pericardium (effusion, tamponade), but can affect myocardium and endo-



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cardium.

### **Cardiac MRI**

Magnetic-resonance imaging of the heart that characterizes ventricular function, myocardial tissue, perfusion, scar, edema, infiltration, and congenital anatomy without ionizing radiation. Gadolinium contrast is avoided or used cautiously in selected patients with severe renal dysfunction.

### **Cardiac Muscle**

Involuntary, striated muscle forming the myocardium. Cardiac muscle cells are electrically connected by intercalated discs, allowing coordinated contraction of the heart.

### **Cardiac Output**

The volume of blood pumped by the heart per minute, calculated as the heart rate multiplied by the stroke volume.

### **Cardiac Output Measurement**

Methods include: thermodilution via pulmonary artery catheter (bolus of cold saline and temperature change measurement), Fick principle ( $O_2$  consumption / arteriovenous  $O_2$  difference), echocardiographic Doppler (flow velocity time integral x valve area x heart rate), and non-invasive cardiac output monitors (bioimpedance, bioreactance).

### **Cardiac Pacemaker Types**

Single-chamber: pacing one chamber (atrium or ventricle). Dual-chamber (DDD): paces and senses both atrium and ventricle, maintaining AV synchrony. Biventricular (CRT): paces both ventricles for resynchronization in heart failure.

### **Cardiac PET**

Viability, perfusion, amyloidosis. Quantitative perfusion measurement.

### **Cardiac PET Imaging**

Positron emission tomography using radiotracers ( $Rb-82$ ,  $N-13$  ammonia,  $O-15$  water) for quantitative myocardial perfusion assessment. Advantages over

SPECT: superior resolution, shorter scan time, attenuation correction, and absolute myocardial blood flow quantification (mL/g/min).

### **Cardiac Radiation Injury**

Late complication of mediastinal radiation therapy (Hodgkin lymphoma, breast cancer, lung cancer). Manifestations include pericardial disease (constrictive pericarditis, effusion), coronary artery disease (accelerated atherosclerosis), valvular disease (fibrosis), myocardial fibrosis, and conduction abnormalities.

### **Cardiac Rehab Outcomes**

Cardiac rehabilitation can improve exercise capacity, cardiovascular risk-factor control, quality of life, and psychological well-being after selected cardiac conditions. The benefits and participation rates vary among populations and programs.

### **Cardiac Rehabilitation**

Supervised program for cardiac patients post-MI, PCI, CABG, heart failure. Phases: inpatient (early mobilization), outpatient (supervised exercise, education), maintenance. Components: exercise training, risk factor modification, psychological support, return to work counseling. Reduces mortality, hospitalizations.

### **Cardiac Resynchronization Therapy**

Biventricular pacing that synchronizes contraction of the left and right ventricles in patients with heart failure, reduced EF, and prolonged QRS duration (especially LBBB). CRT improves symptoms, exercise capacity, and quality of life, and reduces heart failure hospitalizations and mortality.

### **Cardiac Sarcoidosis**

Infiltrative disease characterized by non-caseating granulomas in the myocardium, affecting 25-30% of patients with systemic sarcoidosis. Presentation includes conduction abnormalities (AV block), ventricular arrhythmias, and heart failure.

### **Cardiac Skeleton**

A dense connective tissue framework composed of

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four fibrous rings that surround the heart valves and provide structural support. The cardiac skeleton includes the annuli fibrosi (valve rings), the membranous septum, and the left and right fibrous trigones.

### Cardiac SPECT

A nuclear-imaging method that evaluates myocardial perfusion and can help identify ischemia, infarction, or viable myocardium. When synchronized with the heartbeat, gated images can also assess ventricular motion and function.

### Cardiac Stress Test

Evaluation of cardiac function and ischemia under increased cardiac workload. Exercise stress test (treadmill, Bruce protocol): ECG monitoring for ST-segment changes, symptoms, BP response, and arrhythmias. Sensitivity 65-75% for CAD.

### Cardiac Stress Testing

Assessment of cardiac function under physiological or pharmacological stress to detect ischemia. Exercise stress testing involves treadmill or bicycle exercise with continuous ECG monitoring. Pharmacological stress (dobutamine, adenosine, regadenoson) is used when patients cannot exercise.

### Cardiac Tamponade

Cardiac tamponade occurs when fluid or blood under pressure around the heart restricts filling, reducing cardiac output and potentially causing obstructive shock. and causing reduced circulation. It is a medical emergency.

### Cardiac Tamponade Physiology

Accumulation of pericardial fluid causing compression of cardiac chambers, impairing diastolic filling and reducing cardiac output. Hemodynamic consequences include equalization of diastolic pressures (RA = RV diastolic = PCWP), pulsus paradoxus, and decreased cardiac output.

### Cardiac Tumors

Tumors involving the heart may be primary or metastatic. Primary tumors are rare; myxoma is a

common benign primary tumor and angiosarcoma is a recognized malignant type. Symptoms and treatment depend on the tumor's location, tissue type, obstruction, embolic risk, and spread.

### Cardiac Tumors Management

Myxoma: surgical excision is curative, with low recurrence rate. Benign tumors (rhabdomyoma, fibroma) may be observed if asymptomatic but require surgery if causing obstruction or arrhythmia. Malignant tumors: prognosis is poor; treatment may include surgery, chemotherapy, and radiation depending on tumor type.

### Cardio-Oncology

The subspecialty focusing on cardiovascular care of cancer patients, addressing cancer therapy-related cardiac dysfunction, prevention, and management. Key concerns include anthracycline cardiotoxicity, trastuzumab-related cardiomyopathy, immune checkpoint inhibitor myocarditis, and radiation-induced heart disease.

### Cardiogenic Shock

A state of inadequate tissue perfusion caused by severe cardiac dysfunction. It may produce low blood pressure, altered mental status, cool extremities, reduced urine output, metabolic acidosis, or other signs of organ hypoperfusion.

### Cardiogenic Shock Management

Emergency management of shock caused by severe cardiac dysfunction. It includes support of oxygenation and circulation, treatment of the underlying cause, and selected use of vasopressors, inotropes, mechanical support, or revascularization.

### Cardiology

The branch of medicine devoted to the study, diagnosis, and treatment of disorders of the heart and circulatory system. Cardiologists manage conditions including coronary artery disease, heart failure, valvular heart disease, arrhythmias, cardiomyopathy, pericardial disease, congenital heart disease, and hypertension.

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## Cardiomegaly

Abnormal enlargement of the heart, identified clinically, on chest radiography, or with cardiac imaging. It may reflect chamber dilatation, myocardial hypertrophy, pericardial effusion, or a combination of these; causes include hypertension, valvular disease, cardiomyopathy, congenital heart disease, and high-output states.

## Cardiomyopathy

Cardiomyopathy is disease of the heart muscle that can impair contraction, relaxation, rhythm, or valve function and may lead to heart failure or sudden death. disease, valvular disease, and congenital heart disease as primary causes. The three main types are dilated, hypertrophic, and restrictive cardiomyopathy.

## Cardiomyopathy Classification

The MOGE(S) classification system provides phenotypic and genotypic description: M (morpho-functional phenotype), O (organ/system involvement), G (genetic inheritance), E (etiology), S (functional status/NYHA class).

## Cardioplegia

Deliberate temporary arrest and protection of the heart during cardiac surgery, usually achieved with a cold or blood-based solution that alters myocardial electrical and metabolic activity.

## Cardiopulmonary Exercise Testing

Comprehensive assessment of cardiovascular and pulmonary function during graded exercise on a treadmill or cycle ergometer. Measures: VO<sub>2</sub> max, anaerobic threshold, ventilatory efficiency (VE/VCO<sub>2</sub> slope), and hemodynamic responses.

## Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

A sequence of chest compressions, ventilation, defibrillation when indicated, and advanced life-support interventions for cardiac arrest. Its purpose is to maintain circulation and oxygen delivery until spontaneous circulation is restored or definitive treatment is provided.

## Cardiorenal Syndrome

Dysfunction of the heart and kidneys where acute or chronic failure of one organ contributes to dysfunction of the other. Type 1: acute cardiac dysfunction causing acute kidney injury (e.g., cardiogenic shock). Type 2: chronic cardiac dysfunction causing progressive CKD. Type 3: acute kidney injury causing cardiac dysfunction.

## Cardioselective Beta-Blockers

Cardioselective beta-blockers selectively block beta-1 adrenergic receptors, which are predominant in the heart, while having minimal effects on beta-2 receptors in the bronchial smooth muscle and peripheral vasculature at therapeutic doses. Common cardioselective beta-blockers include metoprolol, atenolol, bisoprolol, and nebivolol.

## Cardiospasm

Spasm or impaired relaxation of the lower esophageal sphincter, historically used as a term for achalasia. It causes dysphagia, regurgitation, and sometimes chest discomfort.

## CTG

Abbreviation for cardiotocography; continuous electronic monitoring of fetal heart rate and uterine contractions during labour.

### Synonyms:

Cardiotocography

## Cardiotocography

A continuous electronic recording of the fetal heart rate and uterine contractions used to assess fetal well-being during pregnancy and labor. The CTG machine uses two transducers placed on the maternal abdomen: an ultrasound transducer records the fetal heart rate, and a tocodynamometer records uterine contractions.

## Cardiotoxicity

Injury or functional impairment of the heart caused by a toxic exposure, systemic disease, or treatment. Manifestations include arrhythmia, myocardial dysfunction, ischemia, or heart failure.

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## Cardiotoxicity From Chemotherapy

Chemotherapy agents that damage the myocardium, most commonly anthracyclines (doxorubicin, daunorubicin). Cardiotoxicity presents as dilated cardiomyopathy with reduced ejection fraction. Risk is dose-dependent (doxorubicin cumulative dose >550 mg/m<sup>2</sup>).

## Cardiovascular Changes In Pregnancy

Plasma volume increases 40-50% (total volume 5 L), red cell mass increases 20-30% (physiologic anemia of pregnancy due to dilution). Cardiac output increases 30-50% by 32 weeks (stroke volume increases initially, then heart rate).

## Cardiovascular Disease

Disease affecting the heart or blood vessels, including coronary artery disease, heart failure, arrhythmias, valvular disease, and vascular disorders.

## Cardiovascular Health

Cardio is shorthand for cardiovascular health or exercise that elevates heart rate and respiratory effort to strengthen the heart, lungs, and circulatory system. Aerobic activities such as walking, running, cycling, and swimming improve cardiac output, lower blood pressure, and enhance metabolic efficiency.

## Cardiovascular Screening

Evaluation of cardiovascular risk or disease in people with or without symptoms. It may include blood-pressure measurement, lipid testing, diabetes assessment, and targeted testing based on age and risk.

## Cardiovascular System

The organ system comprising the heart and blood vessels (arteries, arterioles, capillaries, venules, veins) responsible for circulating blood throughout the body.

## Cardioversion

Restoration of a regular heart rhythm from an arrhythmia, using synchronized electrical shock or medicines; anticoagulation and assessment for atrial thrombus may be needed in atrial fibrillation.

## Cardioversion (Synchronized)

Delivery of an electrical shock synchronized with the QRS complex to restore a more organized cardiac rhythm. It is used for selected tachyarrhythmias, with energy, sedation, anticoagulation, and monitoring determined by the rhythm and the patient's clinical condition.

### Synonyms:

Synchronized

## Carditis

Inflammation of the heart or one of its layers, including the myocardium, endocardium, or pericardium. It may result from infection, immune-mediated disease, or systemic inflammation.

## Care Coordination

Deliberate organization and communication of healthcare activities among professionals, services, patients, and caregivers to support safe, continuous, and appropriate care across settings.

## Caregiver

A person who provides assistance with another person's health care, daily activities, or support. A caregiver may be a family member, friend, or paid professional.

## Caregiver Burden

The emotional, physical, social, or financial strain associated with providing ongoing care for another person.

## Caregiver Stress

Emotional, physical, social, or financial strain associated with providing ongoing care for another person.

## Caries

A biofilm-mediated, multifactorial disease in which acids from bacterial metabolism of fermentable carbohydrates cause net demineralization of enamel, dentin, or cementum. Early lesions may be arrested or remineralized, but progressive disease forms cavities and can reach the pulp, causing pain or infection.

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tion.

### **Caries (Dental)**

A biofilm-mediated, sugar-driven, multifactorial disease causing net demineralization of enamel, dentin, or cementum. Risk is influenced by fermentable-carbohydrate frequency, fluoride exposure, saliva, oral hygiene, tooth anatomy, and previous disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Caries Risk Assessment**

Systematic evaluation of an individual's likelihood of developing dental caries. Low risk: no active caries, good oral hygiene, regular fluoride exposure. Moderate risk: one or more active lesions in past 3 years, fair oral hygiene.

### **Carina**

The ridge at the base of the trachea where it bifurcates into the right and left main bronchi. It is a landmark for endotracheal tube placement and bronchoscopy. The right main bronchus is wider, shorter, and more vertical than the left, making it the preferred path for aspirated foreign bodies.

### **Cariogenic**

Capable of promoting dental caries, especially by producing acid from fermentable carbohydrates or supporting a plaque environment that demineralizes tooth structure.

### **Cariogram**

A computer-based program that illustrates the interaction of caries-related factors and provides an overall caries risk assessment. Factors: diet (content, frequency), bacteria (mutans streptococci, lactobacilli), fluoride exposure, saliva (flow rate, buffering capacity), plaque amount, and clinical/social history.

### **Carney Complex**

Autosomal dominant multiple endocrine neoplasia syndrome (NAME syndrome / LAMB syndrome), caused by PRKAR1A (17q22-24, protein kinase A regulatory subunit type 1A, 70% of cases) or

PRKACA locus.

### **Carnitine**

Transports long-chain fatty acids into mitochondria for beta-oxidation. Deficiency causes hypoketotic hypoglycemia.

### **Caroli Disease**

Congenital, autosomal recessive fibropolycystic liver disease (PKHD1 gene, encodes fibrocystin/polyductin; same gene as infantile polycystic kidney disease) characterized by non-obstructive, segmental, saccular dilation of the larger intrahepatic bile ducts.

### **Carotid Artery**

The paired arterial system supplying the head and neck. Each common carotid artery divides into internal and external carotid arteries; the internal carotid supplies the brain and orbit, while the external carotid supplies most external head and neck structures.

### **Carotid Artery Disease**

Narrowing or blockage of the carotid arteries, most often caused by atherosclerotic plaque. It can reduce cerebral blood flow or release emboli and is an important cause of transient ischemic attack and ischemic stroke.

#### **Synonyms:**

Carotid Insufficiency

### **Carotid Artery Stenting**

Endovascular placement of a stent across a carotid stenosis, usually with embolic-protection strategies, to improve cerebral blood flow and reduce stroke risk in selected patients. Antiplatelet therapy and peri-procedural neurologic monitoring are required.

### **Carotid Bruit**

An audible sound over a carotid artery caused by turbulent blood flow. It may occur with carotid atherosclerosis but does not reliably indicate the severity of stenosis; suspected disease is assessed with appropriate vascular imaging and risk evaluation.



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### **Carotid Cavernous Fistula**

An abnormal communication between the carotid artery or its branches and the cavernous sinus, most commonly traumatic but also spontaneous. Clinical features include pulsatile proptosis, chemosis, bruit over the orbit, and cranial nerve palsies. Diagnosis is by CT or MR angiography.

### **Carotid Cavernous Sinus Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the carotid arterial system and the cavernous sinus, which may cause eye redness, pulsation, proptosis, or impaired vision.

### **Carotid Duplex**

Ultrasound combining B-mode and Doppler imaging of carotid arteries. Assesses stenosis, plaque characterization.

### **Carotid Duplex Ultrasound**

Ultrasound evaluation of the carotid arteries for atherosclerotic plaque and stenosis. Measures peak systolic velocity (PSV) and end-diastolic velocity (EDV) in the internal carotid artery (ICA).

### **Carotid Endarterectomy**

Surgical removal of atherosclerotic plaque from a carotid artery to reduce stroke risk in selected patients. Suitability depends on symptoms, degree of narrowing, operative risk, life expectancy, and current clinical guidance.

### **Carotid Stenosis**

Narrowing of a carotid artery, usually caused by atherosclerosis. It can reduce blood flow to the brain or serve as a source of emboli. Evaluation and treatment depend on symptoms, degree of narrowing, imaging, and overall stroke risk.

### **Carpal Tunnel**

Narrow passageway on the palmar wrist, bounded by carpal bones dorsally and the flexor retinaculum as the roof. Transmits the median nerve and flexor tendons. Carpal tunnel syndrome causes numbness in the lateral 3.5 digits and thenar weakness.

### **Carpal Tunnel Syndrome**

The most common entrapment neuropathy, caused by compression of the median nerve as it passes through the carpal tunnel, a narrow fibro-osseous canal bounded by the carpal bones and the flexor retinaculum (transverse carpal ligament) at the wrist.

#### **Synonyms:**

Median Nerve Compression (Carpal Tunnel Syndrome)

### **Carpal Tunnel Syndrome Tests**

Provocative tests for diagnosing carpal tunnel syndrome. Tinel sign: percuss over median nerve at the carpal tunnel tingling in median distribution. Phalen sign: hold wrists in full flexion for 60 seconds reproduces symptoms. Durkan test (carpal compression): direct compression over carpal tunnel for 30 seconds paresthesias.

### **Carrier**

Individual heterozygous for a recessive genetic disorder. Typically asymptomatic but can pass mutant allele to offspring. Carrier screening recommended for certain populations (e.g., Ashkenazi Jewish for Tay-Sachs).

### **Carrier State**

Asymptomatic infection with pathogen capable of transmission. Examples: typhoid carrier, hepatitis B carrier, meningococcal carrier. Importance: public health control, screening, treatment.

### **Cartilage**

A tough, flexible avascular connective tissue found in joints, the ear, nose, rib cage, and intervertebral discs. Composed of chondrocytes embedded in an extracellular matrix of collagen fibers, proteoglycans, and water, providing resilience and compressive strength.

### **Carvedilol**

A nonselective beta-blocker with additional alpha-1 adrenergic blockade and antioxidant properties, producing vasodilation with balanced reduction of heart rate, contractility, and afterload.



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### Case Definition

Standardized clinical, laboratory, and epidemiologic criteria used to classify a person as a suspected, probable, or confirmed case for surveillance or outbreak investigation. It may differ from the criteria used for individual clinical diagnosis.

### Case Fatality Rate

Proportion of cases dying from disease. Measures severity.

### Case Management

Coordinated planning and follow-up of health and social services to help a person obtain appropriate care, avoid duplication, and meet clinical and functional goals.

### Case-Control Study

Observational study comparing cases with disease to controls without. Looks back at exposures.

### Case-Fatality Rate

Proportion of cases dying from disease. Formula: deaths / cases. Measures severity.

### Caseous Necrosis

A distinctive form of cell death that characteristically occurs in granulomatous infections, most notably tuberculosis. The term derives from the cheese-like, friable, whitish-yellow appearance of the necrotic tissue on gross examination.

### Castleman Disease

Heterogeneous group of lymphoproliferative disorders (angiofollicular lymph node hyperplasia, giant lymph node hyperplasia) sharing lymph node histopathology.

### Cat Scratch Disease

A regional lymphadenitis caused by *Bartonella henselae*, a gram-negative bacillus transmitted to humans through cat scratches, bites, or licks on broken skin, particularly from kittens (which carry higher bacterial loads).

### Cat-Scratch Disease

An infection caused by *Bartonella henselae*, usually transmitted by a scratch or bite from an infected cat. It commonly causes a papule followed by regional lymph-node enlargement, fever, and fatigue; atypical disease may affect the eye, liver, spleen, or nervous system.

### Cat-Scratch Fever

A usually self-limited infection caused by *Bartonella henselae*, commonly producing a papule at the inoculation site and regional lymph-node enlargement.

### Catabolism

The set of metabolic pathways that break down complex molecules into simpler units, releasing energy captured as ATP, NADH, FADH<sub>2</sub>, NADPH. Examples: glycolysis, beta-oxidation, proteolysis, glycogenolysis, nucleotide catabolism.

### Catalepsy

A state of markedly reduced movement and responsiveness in which a person may maintain an imposed posture. It can occur in catatonia and other neurologic or psychiatric conditions.

### Catalyst

A substance that increases the rate of a chemical reaction without being consumed, by lowering the activation energy (providing an alternative reaction pathway). Enzymes are biological catalysts (proteins or ribozymes). Catalysts do not alter the reaction equilibrium ( $\Delta G$ ), only the kinetics.

### Cataract

A cataract is an opacity or clouding of the crystalline lens that impairs the transmission of light to the retina, resulting in blurred vision, glare, decreased contrast sensitivity, and progressive vision loss, and it is the leading cause of preventable blindness worldwide.

### Catastrophic Aging

Rapid functional decline after stressor (illness, surgery, fall). Elderly have decreased reserve, less ability to recover. Prevention: comprehensive as-

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assessment, optimization, early intervention.

### **Catatonia**

A neuropsychiatric syndrome characterized by motor abnormalities including immobility, mutism, posturing, waxy flexibility, stereotypy, mannerisms, grunting, echolalia, and echopraxia. It can occur in mood disorders, psychotic disorders, medical conditions, or as catatonia due to another medical condition.

### **Catch-Up Immunization**

Vaccination of a person who is behind the recommended schedule using age- and risk-appropriate intervals. Doses generally do not need to be restarted because of delay, but minimum ages and intervals must be respected.

### **Catecholamine Crisis**

Acute life-threatening elevation of catecholamines causing severe hypertension, tachycardia, and multi-organ dysfunction. Occurs in pheochromocytoma and paraganglioma precipitated by anesthesia, surgery, trauma, or medications that stimulate catecholamine release.

### **Catecholamines (Urine/Plasma)**

Measurement of catecholamines or their metabolites in blood or urine. These tests help evaluate suspected pheochromocytoma or paraganglioma, but results must be interpreted with medications, stress, sampling conditions, and clinical findings.

#### **Synonyms:**

Urine/Plasma

### **Category I Fetal Heart Tracing**

A normal fetal heart rate tracing by NICHD 2008 criteria. All three characteristics present: baseline 110-160 bpm, moderate variability (6-25 bpm), and no late or variable decelerations. May have accelerations. Category I tracings are associated with normal fetal acid-base status.

### **Category II Fetal Heart Tracing**

An indeterminate fetal heart rate tracing that falls between Category I and III.

### **Category III Fetal Heart Tracing**

An abnormal fetal heart rate tracing indicating potential fetal hypoxia or acidosis. Two specific patterns: (1) absent baseline variability with recurrent late decelerations, (2) absent baseline variability with recurrent variable decelerations, and (3) sinusoidal pattern.

### **Catheter**

Flexible tube for drainage or infusion. Types: urinary (Foley), intravenous, central venous, arterial. Materials: silicone, latex, PVC.

### **Catheter-Associated UTI**

Urinary tract infection related to indwelling urinary catheter. Most common healthcare-associated infection. Risk: prolonged catheterization, female sex, diabetes, immunosuppression. Prevention: avoid unnecessary catheters, aseptic insertion, closed drainage, daily hygiene, early removal.

### **Catheter-Related Infections**

Infections caused by microorganisms entering along or contaminating an intravascular or other indwelling catheter. They may cause local inflammation or bloodstream infection; removal or replacement and antimicrobial treatment depend on the catheter and severity.

### **Catheterization (Urinary)**

Insertion of a flexible tube (catheter) through the urethra or suprapubically into the urinary bladder to drain urine. Types: Foley catheter (indwelling balloon catheter), intermittent (in-out) catheter, and suprapubic catheter.

#### **Synonyms:**

Urinary

### **Cauda Equina Syndrome**

A neurosurgical emergency caused by compression of the cauda equina nerve roots below the level of the conus medullaris (typically at L1-L2 and below), resulting in bilateral lower extremity weakness, sensory loss, and bladder and bowel dysfunction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Syndrome Cauda Equina (Cauda Equina Syndrome)

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## Caudal

Positioned toward the tail or lower part of the body.

## Cauliflower Ear

A permanent deformity of the outer ear caused by blood or fluid collecting between the cartilage and its covering, usually after blunt trauma or repeated friction. Untreated separation can deprive cartilage of blood supply and produce a thickened, irregular ear. Prompt drainage and compression reduce the risk of deformity.

### Synonyms:

Perichondrial Hematoma (Cauliflower Ear)

## Cause Of Death

The specific disease, injury, or toxic agent responsible for initiating the lethal physiological sequence leading directly to death (e.g., Gunshot wound to the head, Acute myocardial infarction).

## Cavernous Sinus Thrombosis

Life-threatening septic thrombosis of the cavernous sinus, usually a complication of mid-face, nasal, paranasal sinus (sphenoid, ethmoid), dental, or orbital infection spreading through the valveless ophthalmic veins.

## CD4 Count

The number of CD4-positive T-helper lymphocytes in a blood sample. It helps assess immune function and risk of opportunistic infection in people with HIV, but interpretation depends on trends, viral load, clinical findings, and current treatment guidance.

## CD4-Positive T Cell

A T lymphocyte that recognizes peptide presented by major histocompatibility complex class II molecules. Its differentiated subsets coordinate immune responses, including macrophage activation, B-cell help, mucosal defense, and immune regulation.

## CD8-Positive T Cell

A T lymphocyte that recognizes peptide pre-

sented by major histocompatibility complex class I molecules. Cytotoxic CD8-positive cells can induce apoptosis in infected, malignant, or otherwise altered target cells.

## CEA (Carcinoembryonic Antigen)

A blood tumor marker used mainly to monitor selected colorectal and other cancers. Levels can be affected by smoking, benign disease, and other malignancies; changes are interpreted with imaging, symptoms, and the clinical context rather than a single cutoff.

### Synonyms:

Carcinoembryonic Antigen

## Cecal Volvulus

Axial twisting of the cecum and ascending colon around its mesentery, accounting for approximately one-third of colonic volvulus cases. It presents with acute or subacute large bowel obstruction, abdominal pain, and distension. Diagnosis is by CT scan showing the characteristic whirl sign and a massively dilated cecum.

## Cecum

First and widest large intestinal part in the right iliac fossa below the ileocecal valve, a blind-ended pouch approximately 6 cm long. Appendix arises from its posteromedial wall approximately 2 cm below the valve, containing abundant lymphoid tissue. Cecal volvulus causes large bowel obstruction.

## Ceftazidime-Avibactam

A combination of the third-generation cephalosporin ceftazidime with the non-beta-lactam beta-lactamase inhibitor avibactam. Avibactam inhibits class A, class C, and some class D beta-lactamases, including KPC carbapenemases. This combination has activity against many carbapenem-resistant Enterobacteriaceae and *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*.

## Celiac Artery

The first major ventral branch of the abdominal aorta at T12, arising from the aorta just below the diaphragm and supplying the foregut (stomach, proximal duodenum, liver, gallbladder, spleen, pan-

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creas). It trifurcates into the left gastric, splenic, and common hepatic arteries, with rich collateral circulation between these branches.

### **Celiac Crisis**

Acute life-threatening presentation of celiac disease characterized by severe dehydration, electrolyte imbalances, metabolic acidosis, hypocalcemic tetany, and hypovolemic shock. Most commonly occurs in infants and young children after a viral illness or introduction of gluten-containing foods.

### **Celiac Disease**

An immune-mediated enteropathy triggered by gluten ingestion in genetically predisposed individuals (HLA-DQ2/DQ8). Gliadin peptides from wheat, barley, and rye activate an autoimmune response against tissue transglutaminase (tTG), causing villous atrophy, crypt hyperplasia, and intraepithelial lymphocytosis in the small intestine.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nontropical Sprue

### **Celiac Trunk**

First major abdominal aortic branch at T12-L1, the foregut artery. Divides into left gastric (lesser curvature), splenic (spleen, pancreas, greater curvature), and common hepatic (proper hepatic/gastroduodenal) arteries. Surrounded by the celiac plexus.

### **Celiac Trunk Stenosis**

Narrowing of the celiac trunk typically caused by extrinsic compression from the median arcuate ligament of the diaphragm, known as median arcuate ligament syndrome or celiac artery compression syndrome. Causes chronic abdominal pain particularly after eating and weight loss due to postprandial mesenteric ischemia.

### **Cell**

The fundamental structural and functional unit of all living organisms. Human cells are eukaryotic, characterized by a nucleus containing DNA and membrane-bound organelles.

### **Cell-Free Fetal DNA Screening**

A prenatal screening test that analyzes placental cell-free DNA in maternal blood to estimate the chance of selected chromosomal conditions. It is usually offered from early pregnancy onward. It is a screening test, not a diagnostic test, and a positive or inconclusive result requires appropriate counseling and follow-up.

### **Cell-Mediated Immunity**

An immune response mediated mainly by T lymphocytes and other cells rather than by antibodies. It is important in defense against intracellular pathogens and in immune surveillance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cell-Mediated Immune Response

### **Cellular Adaptation**

Cellular adaptations are reversible changes in cell morphology and function that occur in response to altered physiological demands or mild pathological conditions.

### **Cellular Swelling**

An early manifestation of reversible injury caused by failure of ATP-dependent ion pumps and intracellular accumulation of sodium and water. It is also called hydropic change and is often most apparent in cells exposed to ischemia or toxins.

#### **Synonyms:**

hydropic change.

### **Cellulitis**

Cellulitis is a bacterial infection of the deeper skin and subcutaneous tissue, causing expanding redness, warmth, swelling, and tenderness with possible systemic illness. commonly caused by beta-hemolytic streptococci (particularly *Streptococcus pyogenes*) or *Staphylococcus aureus*.

### **Cemento-Enamel Junction**

Junction between enamel and cementum. Three relationships: butt junction, enamel overlapping cementum, cementum overlapping enamel.

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## **Cementum**

A mineralized connective tissue covering the tooth root. It provides attachment for periodontal-ligament fibers and is thinner near the cemento-enamel junction and thicker toward the root apex.

## **Centenarian**

Person aged 100 or older. 100,000 worldwide. More women than men (4:1). Often maintain functional independence, cognitive function. Models for healthy aging research.

## **Central**

Located near or toward the middle of the body or an organ.

## **Central Auditory Processing Disorder**

Impaired processing of auditory information by the central nervous system despite adequate peripheral hearing. It may cause difficulty understanding speech, especially in noise, and can affect learning and communication.

## **Central Deafness**

Loss or severe impairment of hearing caused by disease of the auditory pathways or auditory cortex in the brain, rather than by a disorder of the external, middle, or inner ear.

## **Central Diabetes Insipidus**

Excessive urination and thirst caused by deficient secretion of antidiuretic hormone from the hypothalamus or posterior pituitary. The kidneys cannot appropriately concentrate urine, producing hypernatremia if water intake is insufficient.

## **Central Line Placement**

Insertion of a catheter into a central vein (internal jugular, subclavian, or femoral), with the tip in the superior (or inferior) vena cava. Ultrasound guidance is standard. Indications: administration of vasopressors, TPN, chemotherapy, long-term antibiotics, central venous pressure monitoring, hemodialysis, and plasmapheresis.

## **Central Line-Associated Bloodstream Infection**

Bloodstream infection associated with central venous catheter. Prevention: maximal sterile barriers, chlorhexidine skin preparation, optimal site selection (subclavian preferred), daily review of line necessity. Diagnosis: paired blood cultures (peripheral and line). Treatment: antibiotics, catheter removal if possible.

## **Central Nervous System**

The part of the nervous system comprising the brain and spinal cord, enclosed within the skull and vertebral column.

## **Central Pontine Myelinolysis**

A form of osmotic demyelination syndrome caused by overly rapid correction of hyponatremia, leading to demyelination of the central pons. Clinical features include flaccid quadriparesis, pseudobulbar palsy, dysarthria, dysphagia, and in severe cases locked-in syndrome.

## **Central Retinal Artery Occlusion**

Acute obstruction of the central retinal artery causing sudden, usually painless, severe monocular visual loss. It is an ocular stroke and requires urgent systemic and vascular evaluation because it may signal a high risk of cerebral ischemia.

## **Central Serous Chorioretinopathy**

Accumulation of serous fluid beneath the neurosensory retina, usually in the macular region, due to altered choroidal vascular permeability and retinal pigment-epithelium dysfunction. It often causes acute or subacute central visual distortion and may be associated with corticosteroid exposure.

## **Central Sleep Apnea**

Apneas from variability in respiratory effort without airway obstruction. Associated with heart failure (Cheyne-Stokes respiration), high altitude, and opioid use.

### **Synonyms:**

Sleep Apnea, Central



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### Central Venous Catheter

A catheter whose tip terminates in a central vein, usually the lower superior vena cava or cavoatrial junction. It provides reliable access for vasoactive drugs, irritating infusions, hemodynamic monitoring, and prolonged therapy, but may cause bloodstream infection, thrombosis, or mechanical complications.

### Central Venous Pressure

Pressure measured in or near the right atrium, usually through a central venous catheter. It reflects right-sided filling conditions but is affected by ventilation, heart function, vascular tone, and measurement technique; it should not be used alone to guide fluid treatment.

### Centriacinar Emphysema

A subtype of emphysema in which destruction begins in the respiratory bronchioles and extends peripherally. It predominantly affects the upper lobes and is strongly associated with cigarette smoking. It is the most common form of emphysema and often coexists with chronic bronchitis.

### Centrifuge

Spins samples to separate components by density. Used for blood processing, urine analysis, tissue preparation. Speed: RPM or RCF.

### Cephalalgia

Headache or pain in the head, including pain arising from cranial or related structures. It is a symptom with many possible primary and secondary causes.

### Cephalhaematoma

A collection of blood between the periosteum and the skull bone, caused by rupture of blood vessels during childbirth, most commonly associated with ventouse (vacuum) delivery. Unlike caput succedaneum, a cephalhaematoma does not cross suture lines and is limited by the periosteal attachments.

### Cephalohematoma

A collection of blood beneath the periosteum of a newborn's skull, usually caused by birth trauma. It

is confined by suture lines and generally resolves gradually.

### Cephalopelvic Disproportion

A mismatch between the size or shape of the maternal pelvis and the fetal head that prevents or impedes vaginal delivery. It may be suspected from clinical assessment but cannot always be diagnosed reliably before labor.

### Cephalosporin

A class of beta-lactam antibiotics derived from the fungus *Cephalosporium acremonium*, with a mechanism identical to penicillins — inhibition of bacterial cell wall synthesis by binding to penicillin-binding proteins and inhibiting transpeptidase. Cephalosporins are classified into five generations based on their antimicrobial spectrum.

### Ceramide

A sphingolipid composed of a sphingoid base linked to a fatty acid. Ceramides are structural components of cell membranes and the epidermal permeability barrier and also participate in cell signaling.

### Cerclage

A surgical placement of a suture around the cervix to prevent preterm delivery in patients with cervical insufficiency. Types include transvaginal (McDonald or Shirodkar) and transabdominal. Usually placed at 12-14 weeks gestation and removed at 36-37 weeks.

### Cerebellar Ataxia

A neurological sign characterized by impaired coordination of voluntary movements, resulting from dysfunction of the cerebellum or its connections. The cerebellum coordinates the timing, force, and accuracy of movements, and cerebellar dysfunction produces a characteristic constellation of findings.

### Cerebellar Tumor

A neoplasm involving the cerebellum that may cause ataxia, dysmetria, nystagmus, vomiting, or hydrocephalus.



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## Cerebellitis

Inflammation of the cerebellum, often after infection and sometimes associated with an autoimmune response. It may produce ataxia, dysarthria, nystagmus, headache, and altered consciousness.

## Cerebellopontine Angle

The angle-shaped region at the junction of the cerebellum, pons, and petrous temporal bone. Lesions in this space may affect cranial nerves and commonly include vestibular schwannoma.

## Cerebellopontine Angle Tumor

Lesion at the cerebellopontine angle (CPA), an anatomic space between the cerebellum and pons, medial to the temporal lobe and lateral to the brainstem, containing CN V (trigeminal), VII (facial), VIII (vestibulocochlear), and the anterior inferior cerebellar artery (AICA).

## Cerebellum

Largest brain portion (approximately 10 percent of volume but over 50 percent of neurons) in the posterior cranial fossa behind the brainstem. Two hemispheres and a vermis, divided into vestibulocerebellum (balance, eye movements), spinocerebellum (posture, gait, coordination), and cerebrocerebellum (motor planning, cognition).

## Cerebral Amyloid Angiopathy

Deposition of amyloid beta in the walls of small and medium cerebral and leptomeningeal arteries. It commonly causes recurrent lobar intracerebral hemorrhage in older adults and may also cause transient focal neurological episodes or cognitive decline.

## Cerebral Aneurysm

An abnormal focal enlargement of an artery in or around the brain. It may remain asymptomatic or rupture and cause subarachnoid hemorrhage. Risk factors include hypertension, smoking, certain inherited disorders, and family history.

## Cerebral Angiography

Contrast imaging of cerebral vessels. Evaluates

aneurysms, AVMs, stenosis. Invasive procedure.

## Cerebral Arteriovenous Malformation

An abnormal direct connection between cerebral arteries and veins without a normal capillary bed. It may cause intracranial hemorrhage, seizures, headache, or focal neurological deficits and is evaluated with brain imaging and angiography.

## Cerebral Autoregulation

The intrinsic ability of cerebral arterioles to maintain relatively stable cerebral blood flow across a range of perfusion pressures. It may be impaired by severe brain injury, ischemia, hypercapnia, or anesthetic and vasoactive drugs.

## Cerebral Cavernous Malformations

Low-flow vascular malformations composed of dilated, thin-walled capillaries without intervening brain parenchyma, often multiple and familial (autosomal dominant with mutations in CCM1, CCM2, or CCM3 genes). They may present with seizures, focal neurological deficits, or intracerebral hemorrhage.

## Cerebral Cortex

The outermost layer of the cerebrum, composed of gray matter (neuronal cell bodies) folded into gyri (ridges) and sulci (grooves), greatly increasing surface area.

## Cerebral Edema

The accumulation of excess fluid within the brain parenchyma, leading to increased intracranial pressure and potentially fatal brain herniation. There are three main types with different pathophysiological mechanisms.

## Cerebral Hemorrhage

Bleeding within the brain parenchyma, a type of hemorrhagic stroke causing mass effect, edema, and neurological deficits. Causes: hypertension (most common—basal ganglia, thalamus), cerebral amyloid angiopathy (lobar, elderly), arteriovenous malformation, aneurysm, anticoagulants, trauma, tumors.

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## Cerebral Hypoxia

Insufficient oxygen delivery to the brain, caused by cardiac arrest, respiratory failure, severe hypotension, or another interruption of oxygen supply. Prolonged hypoxia can produce permanent neuronal injury and hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy.

## Cerebral Infarction

Cerebral infarction, or ischemic stroke, results from occlusion of a cerebral artery causing irreversible neuronal damage. The most common cause is thromboembolism from atherosclerotic carotid or intracranial arteries, or cardioembolism from atrial fibrillation or cardiac thrombus.

## Cerebral Lobes

Four lobes divided by sulci. Frontal (anterior to central sulcus): executive function, motor control (precentral gyrus), Broca's area. Parietal (between central and parieto-occipital sulci): somatosensory (postcentral gyrus), spatial awareness. Temporal (below lateral sulcus): auditory processing, memory (hippocampus), Wernicke's area.

## Cerebral Palsy

A group of permanent disorders of movement and posture development causing activity limitation, attributed to non-progressive disturbances occurring in the developing fetal or infant brain. It is the most common motor disability in childhood, affecting approximately 1 in 500 live births.

### Synonyms:

Palsy, Cerebral Palsy Cerebral (Cerebral Palsy)

## Cerebral Peduncle

Paired structures of the ventral midbrain carrying descending motor tracts (corticospinal, corticobulbar, corticopontine) connecting the cerebrum to the pons and below. Lesions produce contralateral hemiparesis; Weber syndrome (peduncle + CN III) causes ipsilateral CN III palsy with contralateral hemiparesis.

## Cerebral Perfusion Pressure

The pressure gradient driving blood flow through the brain, approximated as mean arterial pressure

minus intracranial pressure. CPP falls when systemic pressure decreases or ICP rises and must be interpreted with the clinical context.

## Cerebral Salt Wasting

Renal sodium wasting causing hyponatremia and volume depletion occurring after intracranial surgery or in setting of intracranial disease. Distinguished from SIADH by the presence of volume depletion with negative sodium balance and compensatory elevation of renin and aldosterone.

## Cerebral Tumor

A neoplasm arising within or involving the brain, producing symptoms according to its location, growth rate, and effect on intracranial pressure.

## Cerebral Venous Sinus Thrombosis

Thrombosis of the cerebral venous sinuses (most commonly the superior sagittal sinus; also transverse, sigmoid, straight; or cortical veins), with resultant venous hypertension, intracranial hypertension, hemorrhagic cortical infarcts, and venous congestion.

## Cerebral Visual Impairment

Visual impairment caused by damage to the brain's visual pathways or occipital cortex rather than the eye itself; the leading cause of childhood visual impairment in developed countries. Features include poor visual attention, difficulty recognizing faces or objects, and variable vision; management is educational and rehabilitative.

## Cerebriform Nevus Sebaceous

A variant of nevus sebaceous presenting as a soft, cerebriform (brain-like), pedunculated or sessile nodule, often found on the scalp or face. It is a benign adnexal hamartoma composed of sebaceous glands, but like other nevus sebaceous lesions, it carries a low risk of secondary neoplasms and may warrant monitoring or excision.

## Cerebritis

Inflammatory process in brain parenchyma without abscess formation. May precede abscess. Causes:

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bacterial, fungal, parasitic infections. Diagnosis: MRI with contrast showing enhancement. Treatment: antibiotics/antifungals, surgical drainage if abscess forms.

### **Cerebroplacental Ratio**

The ratio of the middle cerebral artery (MCA) pulsatility index to the umbilical artery (UA) pulsatility index. CPR <5th percentile (or <1.0-1.1) suggests fetal brain-sparing effect (vasodilation of cerebral vessels in response to hypoxemia) due to placental insufficiency.

### **Cerebrospinal Fluid**

A clear, colorless fluid that fills the ventricles of the brain, the central canal of the spinal cord, and the subarachnoid space around the brain and spinal cord. Produced primarily by the choroid plexus of the lateral, third, and fourth ventricles ( 500 mL/day, total volume 150 mL in adults).

### **Cerebrospinal Fluid Analysis**

Laboratory examination of cerebrospinal fluid, usually obtained by lumbar puncture. It may assess infection, bleeding, inflammation, demyelinating disease, or malignant cells. Analysis can include opening pressure, appearance, cell counts, protein, glucose, microbiology, and other tests selected for the clinical question.

### **Cerebrovascular Accident**

An acute neurological deficit caused by interruption of blood flow to the brain or bleeding within the brain. See Stroke.

### **Cerebrovascular Accident (Stroke)**

Sudden brain dysfunction caused by interrupted blood flow or bleeding in the brain. See Stroke.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stroke

### **Cerebrum**

The largest part of the brain, comprising two cerebral hemispheres connected by the corpus callosum. Each hemisphere has four lobes: frontal (executive function, motor, Broca's area), parietal (somatosen-

sory, spatial awareness), temporal (auditory, memory, Wernicke's area), occipital (visual processing).

### **Ceruloplasmin**

The principal copper-carrying protein in blood, synthesized mainly by the liver. Its concentration and copper-binding function are clinically relevant in disorders such as Wilson disease.

### **Cerumen**

A substance that helps keep dirt out of the ear and lubricates the skin in the ear. More commonly known as earwax.

### **Cerumen Impaction**

Accumulation of earwax in the external auditory canal that causes symptoms or prevents visualization of the tympanic membrane. It may cause aural fullness, conductive hearing loss, tinnitus, itching, or pain.

### **Cervical Cancer**

A malignant tumour arising from the cervix, most commonly caused by persistent infection with high-risk human papillomavirus. It may be asymptomatic early or cause abnormal vaginal bleeding, discharge, or pelvic pain; prevention and early detection rely on HPV vaccination, screening, and assessment of abnormal results.

### **Cervical Carcinoma**

A malignant tumor of the uterine cervix, most commonly associated with persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection.

### **Cervical Cerclage**

Surgical placement of a non-absorbable suture around the cervix to provide mechanical support and prevent preterm delivery in patients with cervical insufficiency.

### **Cervical Dilatation**

Progressive opening of the cervical os during labor, measured in centimeters from 0 (closed) to 10 cm (fully dilated). The cervix must also efface (thin out)

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before significant dilatation occurs. Cervical status assessed by digital vaginal examination during labor.

### **Cervical Dilation**

The opening of the cervical canal during labor, measured in centimeters from closed (0 cm) to fully dilated (10 cm); required for vaginal delivery. Occurs with effacement (thinning/shortening of the cervix) during the first stage of labor, driven by effective uterine contractions.

### **Cervical Disc Herniation**

A common cause of neck pain and radiculopathy, occurring when the nucleus pulposus of an intervertebral disc in the cervical spine herniates through the annulus fibrosus, compressing adjacent nerve roots or the spinal cord.

### **Cervical Dysplasia**

Abnormal growth of cervical epithelial cells, representing a premalignant condition that may progress to cervical cancer if untreated. Also known as cervical intraepithelial neoplasia (CIN). CIN is caused by persistent infection with high-risk human papillomavirus (HPV) types, most commonly HPV 16 and 18.

#### **Synonyms:**

cervical intraepithelial. Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia) Dysplasia Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia) Squamous Intraepithelial Lesion Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia)

### **Cervical Dystonia**

A focal movement disorder causing involuntary contractions of neck muscles and abnormal positioning of the head. It may produce pain, tremor, and sustained or intermittent twisting of the neck.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dystonia, Cervical Torticollis, Spasmodic

### **Cervical Effacement**

Thinning and shortening of the cervix during labor, measured as a percentage from 0% (thick, normal length) to 100% (paper thin). Effacement precedes and accompanies cervical dilatation. Nulliparous women often efface before dilating; multiparous

women may efface and dilate simultaneously.

### **Cervical Exam In Labor**

A digital vaginal examination used to assess cervical dilation, effacement, consistency, and position, together with the station and position of the fetal head. Serial examinations help assess labor progress.

### **Cervical Incompetence**

The inability of the cervix to maintain pregnancy in the second trimester due to painless cervical dilatation. Results in recurrent second trimester pregnancy loss or preterm delivery. Risk factors include prior cervical trauma, cone biopsy, and congenital anomalies.

### **Cervical Length Screening**

Transvaginal ultrasound measurement of the cervix between 18-24 weeks to assess risk of spontaneous preterm birth. Normal cervix measures greater than 25 mm. Short cervix (less than 25 mm) increases preterm delivery risk. Cervical funneling and dilatation are additional concerning findings.

### **Cervical Mucus**

Secretions from the cervical glands that change throughout the menstrual cycle under hormonal influence. Estrogen produces thin, clear, stretchy mucus favorable for sperm transport around ovulation (spinnbarkeit). Progesterone produces thick, sticky, opaque mucus that forms a plug in the cervical canal during pregnancy.

### **Cervical Polyps**

Usually benign, finger-like growths arising from the endocervical canal or cervix. They may cause irregular bleeding, postcoital bleeding, or vaginal discharge and are often found during a pelvic examination. Symptomatic or atypical polyps are removed and sent for pathology.

### **Cervical Pregnancy**

A rare ectopic pregnancy (0.1-1%) implanted in the cervical canal. Presents with painless vaginal bleeding in the first trimester. Diagnosis: ultrasound (hourglass-shaped uterus, gestational sac in

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the cervix with absent sliding sign, empty uterine cavity). High risk of severe hemorrhage.

### **Cervical Radiculopathy**

A condition caused by compression, irritation, or inflammation of a spinal nerve root in the cervical spine, resulting in pain, numbness, tingling, and weakness in the distribution of the affected nerve root.

### **Cervical Rib**

An extra rib arising from a cervical vertebra, usually the seventh. It may be asymptomatic or contribute to thoracic outlet syndrome by compressing the brachial plexus or subclavian vessels.

### **Cervical Ripening Agents**

Medicines or mechanical devices used to soften and prepare the cervix before labor induction. Options include prostaglandins and cervical balloons; selection and dosing depend on the cervix, pregnancy, contraindications, and local obstetric protocol.

### **Cervical Screening (Pap Smear)**

Screening for cervical cancer by collecting cells from the transformation zone of the cervix. Liquid-based cytology (ThinPrep) or conventional Pap smear. HPV co-testing (high-risk HPV 16, 18, others) improves sensitivity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pap Smear

### **Cervical Spine**

The upper segment of the vertebral column consisting of seven cervical vertebrae, C1 through C7, supporting the head and protecting the cervical spinal cord. It permits substantial flexion, extension, rotation, and lateral flexion while transmitting the vertebral arteries through the transverse foramina of C1-C6.

### **Cervical Spine Trauma**

Injury to the cervical spine that may affect the vertebrae, discs, ligaments, spinal cord, or nerve roots. Evaluation includes the mechanism, examination, and appropriate imaging; classification systems can

help guide treatment, which depends on stability and neurologic findings.

### **Cervical Spondyloarthropathy**

A degenerative condition of the cervical spine involving disc degeneration, osteophyte formation, and facet joint arthropathy that may compress nerve roots or the spinal cord. It can cause neck pain, radiculopathy, or myelopathy, and is a common cause of cervical spinal stenosis in older adults.

### **Cervical Spondylosis**

Age-related degenerative changes of the cervical spine—disc degeneration, osteophyte formation, facet joint arthritis, and ligament hypertrophy—affecting the intervertebral discs, vertebrae, and joints.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cervical Osteoarthritis Osteoarthritis, Cervical Spondylosis, Cervical

### **Cervical Vertebrae**

The seven vertebrae of the neck. Typical cervical vertebrae have small bodies, bifid spinous processes, and transverse foramina transmitting the vertebral vessels; C1, C2, and C7 are specialized.

### **Cervicitis**

Cervicitis is inflammation of the uterine cervix, commonly from sexually transmitted infection, bacterial imbalance, irritation, or allergy.

### **Cervix**

The cervix is the lower part of the uterus projecting into the vagina and producing mucus, allowing menstrual flow out and sperm passage in.

### **Cesarean Delivery**

Surgical delivery of the fetus through abdominal and uterine incisions. Performed when vaginal delivery is contraindicated or fails. Indications include malpresentation, placenta previa, previous cesarean, fetal distress, and failed induction. Most common uterine incision is low transverse (classical for very preterm or transverse lie).



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## Cesarean Section

C-section: surgical delivery of the infant through incisions in the abdominal wall and uterus. Indications: fetal distress, failure to progress, malpresentation (breech, transverse), placenta previa, abruption, previous cesarean (some), multiple pregnancy, preeclampsia, cord prolapse, and maternal conditions.

## Cesarean Section (C-Section)

Surgical delivery of a fetus through incisions in the abdominal wall (laparotomy) and uterus (hysterotomy).

### Synonyms:

C-section

## Cestodiasis

Infection or infestation caused by cestodes, commonly called tapeworms. Disease may involve the intestine or tissues, depending on the species and life-cycle stage.

### Synonyms:

tapeworms.

## CFTR Modulator Therapy

Targeted therapies correcting the defective CFTR protein. Elexacaftor-tezacaftor-ivacaftor (Trikafta) is the most effective combination for patients with at least one F508del mutation. These therapies have dramatically changed CF prognosis.

## Chagas Disease

A parasitic infection caused by *Trypanosoma cruzi*, transmitted by reduviid bugs (kissing bugs), endemic in Latin America. Acute phase: fever, swelling at bite site (chagoma), Romana sign (peri-orbital edema). Chronic phase (years later): Chagas cardiomyopathy (most common and serious), megaeosophagus, and megacolon.

### Synonyms:

Trypanosomiasis, American

## Chagoma

A localized inflammatory lesion at the site where *Trypanosoma cruzi* enters the body. It is an early

manifestation of Chagas disease and may be accompanied by regional lymphadenopathy.

## Chain Of Custody

Meticulous paper trail and chronological documentation tracking the seizure, custody, control, transfer, analysis, and disposition of physical and electronic evidence in medico-legal investigations (e.g., blood samples for toxicology, bullets, sexual assault kits, biological fluids).

## Chalazion

A usually painless, firm eyelid lump caused by blockage and inflammation of a meibomian oil gland; persistent or atypical lesions require ophthalmic assessment.

## Chancre

A usually painless ulcer at the site of inoculation of an infection, especially the primary lesion of syphilis. It may be accompanied by regional lymph-node enlargement and heals without treatment, although infection persists.

## Chancroid

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Haemophilus ducreyi*, characterized by painful ragged genital ulcers and tender suppurative inguinal lymph nodes.

## Channelopathy

A disorder caused by abnormal structure or function of an ion channel or its regulatory proteins. Channelopathies can affect excitable tissues and cause neurologic, muscular, or cardiac disease.

## Charcoal

Fine black powder produced by controlled pyrolysis of organic materials, processed to yield a massive micro-porous surface area (500-1500 m<sup>2</sup>/g). See activated charcoal.

## Charcot Arthropathy

Progressive destruction and deformity of a joint caused by loss of protective pain or proprioceptive



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sensation. It is most often associated with peripheral neuropathy, particularly diabetic neuropathy.

### **Charcot Foot**

A progressive destructive arthropathy of the foot and ankle, usually occurring in people with peripheral neuropathy, especially diabetes. Repeated unnoticed trauma causes warmth, swelling, deformity, instability, and an increased risk of ulceration and amputation.

### **Charcot Joint**

Progressive, neurotrophic arthropathy caused by loss of sensation (proprioception and pain) leading to joint destruction with bone fragmentation, joint dislocation, deformity, and loss of normal pain and proprioceptive sensation in the affected limb.

### **Charcot Triad**

Clinical constellation of fever, right upper quadrant pain, and jaundice representing the classic presentation of ascending cholangitis, infection of the biliary tree from common bile duct obstruction by a gallstone. The full triad is found in approximately fifty to seventy percent of patients.

### **Charcot Triad (Cholangitis)**

Classic diagnostic triad of acute ascending cholangitis: (1) Fever, (2) Right Upper Quadrant abdominal pain, and (3) Jaundice. Reynolds Pentad adds Hypotension and Altered Mental Status. See Acute Cholangitis.

**Synonyms:**  
Cholangitis

### **Charcot-Marie-Tooth Disease**

Group of inherited peripheral neuropathies (hereditary motor and sensory neuropathy, HMSN), the most common inherited neuromuscular disorder (prevalence 1 in 2,500). More than 100 causative genes (PMP22, MPZ, GJB1, MFN2, NEFL).

**Synonyms:**  
Neuropathy, Hereditary Motor And Sensory Peroneal Muscular Atrophy

### **CHARGE Syndrome**

A genetic disorder caused by CHD7 gene mutations (autosomal dominant, most cases de novo) affecting multiple organ systems.

### **Checkpoint Inhibitor**

A medicine that blocks an inhibitory immune-checkpoint pathway, helping selected immune cells recognize and attack tumor cells. Examples target PD-1, PD-L1, or CTLA-4.

### **Checkpoints**

Immune regulatory molecules. Cancer exploits checkpoints. Inhibitors block checkpoints.

### **Chediak-Higashi Syndrome**

Autosomal recessive (LYST mutation, lysosomal trafficking regulator). Giant lysosomal granules in neutrophils, melanocytes, neurons. Partial oculocutaneous albinism, silvery hair, photophobia, nystagmus.

### **Cheilectropion**

An eversion deformity of the lip, usually involving the lower lip. It may result from scarring, congenital malformation, or loss of tissue support.

### **Cheilitis**

Inflammation of one or both lips, causing dryness, scaling, fissuring, erythema, swelling, pain, or ulceration. Causes include irritant or allergic contact exposure, infection, nutritional deficiency, chronic sun exposure, and inflammatory skin disease; persistent lesions require evaluation for premalignant or malignant change.

### **Cheiloplasty**

Plastic or reconstructive surgery of the lip, performed to repair congenital clefting, trauma, tumors, scars, or other deformity.

### **Cheiloschisis**

Cleft lip, a congenital fissure of the upper lip caused by incomplete fusion of facial processes during embryonic development. It may occur alone or with

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cleft palate.

### **Cheilosis**

A disorder of the lips characterized by dryness, scaling, fissuring, or inflammation. Causes include irritation, nutritional deficiency, infection, and systemic disease.

### **Cheiopompholyx**

A form of dyshidrotic eczema affecting the hands, with intensely itchy small vesicles on the palms or sides of the fingers.

### **Chelation**

The formation of a stable complex between a metal ion and a molecule with multiple binding sites. In medicine, chelation can be used under supervision to bind and promote elimination of selected toxic metals.

### **Chelation Study**

Nuclear medicine study using chelating agents. Evaluates renal function, obstruction.

### **Chelation Therapy**

Use of chelating agents to bind metals for excretion. Agents: EDTA (lead), deferoxamine (iron), dimercaprol (arsenic, mercury, gold), DMSA (lead, mercury), penicillamine (copper, lead). Complications: nephrotoxicity, electrolyte disturbances, redistribution of metals.

### **Chemical Eye Injury**

Ocular damage caused by exposure to an acidic or alkaline substance. Immediate copious irrigation, removal of particulate material, measurement of ocular-surface pH, and urgent ophthalmic assessment are required; alkali injuries may penetrate deeply and continue to worsen after exposure.

### **Chemical Injury**

Tissue damage from corrosive substances. Acid burns: coagulation necrosis, eschar formation. Alkali burns: liquefaction necrosis, deeper penetration. Management: copious irrigation, remove contami-

nated clothing, assess for airway involvement.

### **Chemical Peels**

Chemical peels use acids to exfoliate skin layers. Superficial peels (glycolic acid 20 to 70 percent, salicylic acid 20 to 30 percent) affect the epidermis. Medium peels (trichloroacetic acid 35 to 50 percent) reach the papillary dermis. Deep peels (phenol 88 percent) reach the reticular dermis.

### **Chemical Pneumonitis**

Inflammation and lung injury caused by inhalation or aspiration of irritating chemicals, gastric contents, hydrocarbons, or other toxic substances. It may cause cough, dyspnea, hypoxemia, wheezing, and diffuse pulmonary infiltrates.

### **Chemodectoma**

A tumor arising from paraganglionic tissue, especially a carotid-body tumor. It is usually slow-growing and may compress nearby cranial nerves or vessels.

### **Chemoembolization**

A procedure that combines delivery of an antineoplastic agent with embolization of the blood supply to a tumor, most commonly for selected liver cancers.

### **Chemokine**

A family of small secreted cytokines that direct leukocyte migration (chemotaxis) to sites of infection, inflammation, and tissue repair. Classified by cysteine motif: CXC (e.g., IL-8/CXCL8, recruit neutrophils), CC (e.g., MCP-1/CCL2, attract monocytes), C, and CX3C.

### **Chemokinesis**

Nonspecific stimulation of cell movement by a chemical substance, without directional movement toward or away from a concentration gradient.

### **Chemophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of chemicals, sometimes associated with anxiety or obsessive concerns

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about contamination or toxicity.

### **Chemoprevention**

The use of drugs or natural agents to prevent, delay, or reverse cancer development, e.g., tamoxifen or raloxifene in high-risk breast cancer, HPV and hepatitis B vaccination, and aspirin in colorectal cancer.

### **Chemoradiation**

The concurrent combination of chemotherapy and radiation therapy, used to treat locoregionally advanced cancers such as anal, cervical, head and neck, esophageal, and limited-stage small cell lung cancer.

### **Chemoreceptor**

A sensory receptor that responds to changes in blood or CSF chemistry, involved in respiratory and cardiovascular regulation.

### **Chemoreceptor Trigger Zone**

A region near the floor of the fourth ventricle that detects emetic stimuli in blood and cerebrospinal fluid and helps initiate vomiting.

### **Chemoresistance**

Reduced or absent responsiveness of cells, especially tumor cells, to a chemical treatment that would ordinarily inhibit or destroy them.

### **Chemosensitivity**

The degree to which cells or a tumor respond to a chemical treatment. Testing may be used experimentally or clinically to help characterize treatment response.

### **Chemosis**

Chemosis is swelling of the conjunctiva, the membrane over the eye surface, caused by allergy, infection, irritation, trauma, or systemic fluid imbalance.

### **Chemotaxis**

Directed movement of a cell or organism toward or away from a chemical stimulus. It is important in immune-cell recruitment and inflammatory re-

sponses.

### **Chemotherapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to chemotherapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Chemotherapy Extravasation**

Leakage of an intravenous anticancer drug into surrounding tissue. Vesicant extravasation can cause severe local injury, so infusion must stop immediately while the catheter is managed and drug-specific antidote and surgical guidance are obtained.

### **Cherry Angioma**

A common benign proliferation of small dermal blood vessels that appears as a bright-red to purple papule, usually on the trunk or limbs. Lesions may bleed after trauma but generally require no treatment unless diagnosis is uncertain or removal is desired.

### **Cherry Eye**

Prolapse of the gland of the third eyelid, producing a rounded red mass at the inner corner of the eye. The term is used especially in veterinary ophthalmology.

### **Cherry-Red Spot**

A striking fundoscopic finding in which the macula appears bright red against a pale, ischemic, or lipid-laden surrounding retina. Mechanism: the fovea centralis lacks inner retinal layers and receives blood supply from the underlying choroid, preserving its natural red color while adjacent edematous retina turns opaque white.

### **Cherubism**

A rare inherited disorder characterized by bilateral enlargement of the jaws from expansile giant-cell lesions, usually beginning in childhood and often regressing after puberty.

### **Chest Pain**

A cardinal symptom with cardiac and non-cardiac

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causes requiring urgent distinction. Cardiac: acute coronary syndrome (angina, MI), pericarditis, aortic dissection, myocarditis. Pulmonary: pulmonary embolism, pneumothorax, pneumonia, pleurisy. GI: GERD, esophageal spasm, peptic ulcer. Musculoskeletal and psychogenic causes also common.

**Synonyms:**

Pain, Chest

### Cough In Adults

A cough in an adult may be acute, subacute, or chronic and may result from infection, asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, reflux, upper-airway cough syndrome, medication, or other disease. Coughing blood, breathing difficulty, chest pain, low oxygen, or persistent unexplained cough requires medical assessment.

### Chest Physiotherapy

Techniques to mobilize and clear secretions from the lungs, including postural drainage, percussion, vibration, and huffing. It is used in bronchiectasis, CF, and post-operative patients. Positive expiratory pressure devices and oscillating PEP devices are also used.

### Chest Tube Insertion

Placement of a thoracostomy tube in the safe triangle (latissimus dorsi, pectoralis major, nipple level) to drain air, fluid, or blood from the pleural space. Connected to underwater seal drainage.

### Chest Tube Thoracostomy

Insertion of a tube into the pleural space to drain air, fluid, or blood. Indications: pneumothorax (large, tension, or on mechanical ventilation), hemothorax, pleural effusion (empyema, malignant, transudative), and postoperative (cardiac, thoracic surgery).

### Chest Wall

The musculoskeletal boundary of the thoracic cavity, formed by the skin, fascia, muscles, ribs, costal cartilages, sternum, thoracic vertebrae, and associated neurovascular structures. It protects the thoracic organs and participates in breathing through coordinated movement of the ribs and respiratory muscles.

### Chest Wall Deformity

Abnormalities of the chest wall that can affect lung function. Pectus excavatum (sunken sternum) may compress the heart and lungs. Pectus carinatum (protruding sternum) is usually cosmetic. Scoliosis can cause restrictive lung disease. These may require surgical correction if severe.

### Chest X-Ray

Initial imaging for respiratory symptoms. PA and lateral views. Evaluates pneumonia, pneumothorax, pleural effusion, heart size, mediastinal masses. Limited sensitivity for early disease.

### Chewing

Mastication of food. Teeth, muscles, joints coordinated. Difficulties: dental pain, missing teeth, TMJ disorder.

### Cheyne-Stokes Respiration

Crescendo-decrescendo breathing pattern with periods of apnea, seen in heart failure and stroke. It is a form of central sleep apnea.

### Chiari I Malformation

Downward displacement of the cerebellar tonsils through the foramen magnum, which may cause headache, neck pain, balance problems, or no symptoms.

### Chiari Malformation

Chiari malformations are structural abnormalities of the posterior fossa and cerebellum characterized by downward displacement of the cerebellar tonsils through the foramen magnum. Type I is the most common variant, defined as cerebellar tonsillar ectopia of five millimeters or more below the foramen magnum.

### Chiari-Frommel Syndrome

Persistent postpartum secretion of milk with absence of menstruation, associated with hyperprolactinemia after pregnancy. It is a form of galactorrhea-amenorrhea syndrome.

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## Chickenpox

Chickenpox is a contagious varicella-zoster virus infection characterized by an itchy vesicular rash; complications are more likely in adults, pregnancy, immunosuppression, and some infants. in different stages (macules, papules, vesicles, crusts). Highly contagious via respiratory droplets and contact with lesions. Incubation 10-21 days. Complications include secondary bacterial infection, pneumonia, encephalitis, and Reye syndrome.

## Chignon

A temporary swelling (edema) on the baby's scalp caused by the vacuum cap used during ventouse (vacuum) assisted delivery. The chignon forms as the vacuum creates negative pressure pulling the scalp tissue into the cup. It settles within 24-48 hours after birth without any treatment.

## Chikungunya

An acute mosquito-borne viral infection characterized by fever and often severe joint pain, with rash and other systemic symptoms in some patients.

## Chikungunya Fever

An acute febrile illness caused by chikungunya virus and transmitted primarily by *Aedes* mosquitoes. It typically causes abrupt fever, severe symmetrical polyarthralgia, myalgia, headache, and rash; joint symptoms may persist for months or longer, especially in older adults or people with pre-existing rheumatic disease.

## Chikungunya Virus

Chikungunya virus is a mosquito-borne alphavirus that causes abrupt fever and severe joint pain, with arthralgia sometimes persisting for months. severe joint pain. The virus is transmitted by *Aedes* mosquitoes. Symptoms include fever, rash, and polyarthralgia that can be debilitating. Most patients recover fully, but some develop chronic joint pain lasting months to years.

## Chilblain

An inflammatory skin lesion caused by an abnormal response to cold and damp conditions. It produces

itchy, red or violaceous swollen areas, usually on fingers, toes, ears, or nose.

## Child Abuse

Physical, sexual, or emotional harm or neglect of a child by a caregiver. Recognized by inconsistent histories, injury patterns inconsistent with mechanism, and behavioral indicators. Types: physical abuse, sexual abuse, neglect, and emotional abuse. Mandatory reporting requirements for healthcare providers.

### Synonyms:

Child Maltreatment

## Child Neglect

The failure of a caregiver to provide adequate food, shelter, clothing, supervision, education, or medical care. The most common form of child maltreatment. Types: physical neglect, educational neglect, emotional neglect, and medical neglect. May result in failure to thrive, developmental delay, and chronic illness.

## Child Poisoning

Exposure of a child to a medicine, chemical, or other substance that may cause harm. Suspected poisoning requires prompt expert assessment.

## Child-Pugh Classification

Clinical scoring system assessing prognosis of chronic liver disease by evaluating five parameters: total bilirubin, serum albumin, international normalized ratio, ascites, and hepatic encephalopathy. Each parameter is scored one to three points.

## Childbirth

The process of giving birth, encompassing three stages: (1) First stage: from the onset of regular uterine contractions (cervical effacement and dilation) to full dilation (10 cm). See Parturition (Childbirth).

## Childhood Absence Epilepsy

An epilepsy syndrome beginning in childhood with frequent brief absence seizures, characterized by sudden impairment of awareness and a typical gen-

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eralized spike-and-wave EEG pattern.

### **Childhood Obesity**

Excess body fat in a child or adolescent, assessed using age- and sex-specific body-mass-index percentiles. It reflects interacting genetic, behavioral, environmental, and medical factors and increases later cardiometabolic risk. Evaluation should be non-stigmatizing and include growth pattern, nutrition, activity, sleep, and comorbidities.

#### **Synonyms:**

Obesity, Childhood

### **Chills**

A sensation of cold with involuntary shivering, commonly accompanying fever or infection; chills without measured fever may also occur with anxiety, hypoglycaemia, or environmental cold.

### **Chimerism**

The presence in one individual of cell populations derived from genetically different zygotes or sources. It may occur naturally, after transplantation, or through exchange of cells between a pregnant person and fetus.

### **Chionablepsia**

Temporary visual impairment caused by exposure to intense reflected light from snow or ice, commonly called snow blindness. It is usually related to ultraviolet injury of the cornea.

#### **Synonyms:**

snow blindness.

### **Chlamydia**

A genus of obligate intracellular bacteria; *Chlamydia trachomatis* commonly causes sexually transmitted urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, and neonatal conjunctivitis or pneumonia.

### **Chlamydia Trachomatis Infection**

A bacterial infection transmitted mainly through sexual contact. It may cause urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, proctitis, or no symptoms.

### **Chlamydial Pneumonia**

Pneumonia caused by *Chlamydia* species, usually producing a gradual cough, fever, and malaise.

### **Chlamydiosis**

Infection caused by bacteria of the genus *Chlamydia*. Depending on the species and site, it may cause sexually transmitted infection, conjunctivitis, pneumonia, or other disease.

### **Chlamydophila Pneumonia**

Atypical pneumonia with mild presentation: sore throat, hoarseness, cough. Treatment is macrolides or tetracyclines.

### **Chloasma**

Patchy brown hyperpigmentation, especially of the face, associated with pregnancy, hormones, sun exposure, or other causes. It is commonly called melasma.

#### **Synonyms:**

melasma.

### **Chloracne**

An acne-like eruption caused by exposure to certain halogenated aromatic compounds, such as dioxins and related industrial chemicals.

### **Chloramphenicol**

A broad-spectrum antibiotic with activity against gram-positive and gram-negative organisms, as well as *Rickettsia*. Chloramphenicol inhibits bacterial protein synthesis by binding to the 50S ribosomal subunit. It is indicated for serious infections when other agents are not appropriate, including bacterial meningitis and typhoid fever.

### **Chloranemia**

Anemia in which the red blood cells are abnormally pale, usually because of reduced hemoglobin content, as in iron deficiency.

### **Chloroleukemia**

A rare form of myeloid leukemia associated with greenish tumor masses composed of myeloid cells,



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also called granulocytic sarcoma or chloroma.

**Synonyms:**

granulocytic sarcoma or chloroma.

**Chloroma**

A greenish extramedullary mass of immature myeloid cells, usually associated with acute myeloid leukemia. It is also called granulocytic sarcoma or myeloid sarcoma.

**Synonyms:**

granulocytic sarcoma or myeloid sarcoma.

**Chloropsia**

A visual disturbance in which objects appear green or have a greenish tint. It can occur with retinal disease, medication or toxin exposure, or other visual-pathway disorders.

**Choanal Atresia**

A congenital obstruction of the posterior nasal passage (choana) due to failure of the buconasal membrane to rupture during embryogenesis. Bilateral choanal atresia presents as a respiratory emergency in the newborn, who is an obligate nasal breather — cyclic cyanosis that improves with crying.

**Choking**

Airway obstruction caused by an object lodged in the pharynx or larynx, producing impaired ventilation. Complete obstruction can cause hypoxic brain injury and death within minutes; treatment depends on the patient's age, consciousness, and effectiveness of coughing.

**Cholangiitis**

Inflammation of the bile ducts. It may be caused by infection, obstruction, autoimmune disease, or other biliary disorders.

**Cholangiocarcinoma**

Cholangiocarcinoma is cancer arising from bile-duct lining cells and may cause jaundice, itching, abdominal symptoms, or bile-flow obstruction.

**Synonyms:**

Bile Duct Cancer (Cholangiocarcinoma)

**Cholangiography**

Contrast imaging of bile ducts. Intraoperative, percutaneous, or ERCP approach. Evaluates biliary obstruction, stones, strictures.

**Cholangitis**

Cholangitis is inflammation or infection of the bile ducts, often from obstruction by a stone or stricture, and can rapidly cause sepsis.

**Cholecystectomy**

Surgical removal of the gallbladder, usually by a laparoscopic approach when appropriate. It may be performed for symptomatic gallstones, acute cholecystitis, selected gallstone pancreatitis, or other gallbladder disease.

**Cholecystitis**

Inflammation of the gallbladder, most commonly caused by obstruction of the cystic duct by a gallstone, which occurs in approximately 95 percent of cases. The obstruction leads to bile stasis, increased intraluminal pressure, and ischemia of the gallbladder wall, which may progress to bacterial infection.

**Synonyms:**

Inflamed Gallbladder

**Cholecystoses**

Non-inflammatory disorders causing deposits, wall thickening, or other structural changes in the gallbladder, including cholesterosis and adenomyomatosis. Many are incidental, but symptoms and imaging findings determine whether further evaluation is needed.

**Cholangiohepatitis**

Inflammation involving both the bile ducts and liver, often associated with ascending bacterial infection, biliary obstruction, parasites, or recurrent cholangitis. It may cause fever, right-upper-quadrant pain, jaundice, and cholestatic liver-test abnormalities.

**Cholecystography**

Radiographic examination of the gallbladder, usu-

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ally after administration of a contrast substance, to assess its filling, concentration, and emptying.

### **Cholecystokinin**

CCK is a peptide hormone produced by I-cells in the duodenal and jejunal mucosa in response to fatty acids (long-chain fatty acids are the most potent stimuli) and amino acids in the chyme.

### **Choledochal Cyst**

Congenital dilatation of the biliary tree classified into five types according to the Todani classification. Type I involving dilation of the common bile duct is the most common. Presents with the classic triad of abdominal pain, jaundice, and palpable mass though all three are present in less than twenty percent of cases.

### **Choledocholithiasis**

A gallstone within the common bile duct, which may cause biliary pain, jaundice, cholangitis, or pancreatitis and is usually evaluated with liver tests and imaging.

### **Cholelithiasis**

The presence of stones in the gallbladder or biliary tract. Stones may contain cholesterol, pigment, or mixed material and may cause no symptoms or lead to biliary pain and complications.

### **Cholera**

An acute intestinal infection caused by toxigenic *Vibrio cholerae*, producing profuse watery diarrhoea and potentially life-threatening dehydration; prompt oral or intravenous rehydration is central treatment.

### **Cholestasis**

Reduced formation or flow of bile, causing conjugated hyperbilirubinaemia, itching, dark urine, pale stools, and raised alkaline phosphatase; obstruction and intrahepatic causes must be distinguished.

### **Cholesteatoma**

A keratin-filled sac of abnormal squamous epithe-

lium in the middle ear or mastoid that can erode bone and cause chronic discharge, hearing loss, or intracranial complications.

### **Chronic Suppurative Otitis Media**

Persistent inflammation and infection of the middle ear with recurrent or continuous ear discharge, usually through a perforated tympanic membrane. It can cause conductive hearing loss and may lead to cholesteatoma or other complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

CSOM; chronic otitis media with discharge; chronic suppurative middle-ear infection.

### **Cholesterol And Lipids**

Fatty substances in the blood, including LDL cholesterol, HDL cholesterol, and triglycerides, that play critical roles in cellular function and energy metabolism. Abnormal lipid levels, particularly high LDL and triglycerides with low HDL, promote atherosclerosis and increase the risk of heart attack and stroke.

### **Cholesterol Crystal Embolization**

Atheroembolic disease caused by cholesterol crystal fragments dislodging from proximal atherosclerotic plaques into distal small arteries, often after vascular procedures. Presents with livedo reticularis, blue-toe syndrome, renal failure, and eosinophilia. Diagnosis by skin, kidney, or muscle biopsy.

### **Cholesterol Crystals**

Needle-shaped, cleft-like spaces seen in histological sections representing dissolved cholesterol esters, commonly found in atherosclerotic plaques, atheroembolic disease, and cholesterol-rich effusions. In atheroembolic disease, cholesterol crystals embolize from ruptured plaques to distal organs causing tissue ischemia.

### **Cholesterol Emboli**

Cholesterol crystals released from an atherosclerotic plaque that lodge in small arteries and cause ischemia or inflammation in downstream tissues.

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### **Cholesterol Embolism**

Blockage of small arteries by cholesterol crystals, often after vascular instrumentation or plaque disruption.

### **Cholesterol Embolization**

Release and downstream lodging of cholesterol crystals from an atherosclerotic arterial plaque.

### **Cholesterol Synthesis**

Occurs in all nucleated cells (primarily liver and intestine, approximately 1 g/day production), using acetyl-CoA as the precursor through approximately 30 enzymatic steps.

### **Cholesterolemia**

The presence and concentration of cholesterol in the blood. Abnormal elevation is a risk factor for atherosclerotic cardiovascular disease.

### **Cholinergic Crisis**

Excess acetylcholine from organophosphate or carbamate poisoning. SLUDGE syndrome: salivation, lacrimation, urination, defecation, GI upset, emesis. Miosis, bradycardia, bronchospasm, muscle fasciculations. Treatment: atropine, pralidoxime.

### **Cholinesterase Inhibitor**

A class of medications that inhibit acetylcholinesterase, the enzyme that breaks down acetylcholine in the synaptic cleft, thereby increasing cholinergic neurotransmission in the central nervous system and peripheral tissues.

### **Chondritis**

Inflammation of cartilage, such as the cartilage of the ear, nose, ribs, or larynx. It may result from infection, trauma, or immune-mediated disease.

### **Chondroblastic Osteosarcoma**

A variant of osteosarcoma in which the malignant cells produce a cartilaginous matrix. It typically affects the long bones of adolescents and young adults, with a predilection for the metaphyseal regions.

### **Chondrocalcinosis**

Calcification of cartilage visible on X-ray. Associated with CPPD disease. Found in knees, wrists, pubic symphysis. May be incidental or symptomatic.

### **Chondrodysplasia**

A disorder of cartilage and bone development that causes abnormal skeletal growth and, in some forms, disproportionate short stature.

### **Chondroma**

Benign cartilage-forming tumor composed of mature hyaline cartilage, most often intramedullary (enchondroma) or subperiosteal (juxtacortical / periosteal chondroma).

### **Chondromalacia**

Softening and degeneration of cartilage, especially articular cartilage. The term is often used for changes affecting the patella and causing anterior knee pain.

### **Chondrosarcoma**

The second most common primary malignant bone tumor (after osteosarcoma) and the most common primary malignant bone tumor in adults (peak age 40-70 years).

### **Chopart's Joint**

The transverse tarsal joint, consisting of the talonavicular and calcaneocuboid joints, between the hindfoot and the midfoot.

### **Chordae Tendineae**

Thin tendinous cords connecting the papillary muscles to the free edges of the atrioventricular valve leaflets (mitral and tricuspid). They tether the leaflets and, with papillary muscle contraction during ventricular systole, prevent valve prolapse and regurgitation.

### **Chordoma**

Slow-growing, locally aggressive malignant bone tumor originating from embryonic remnants of the notochord along the axial skeleton. Three anatomic

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locations: (1) sacrococcygeal ( 50% of cases, most common), (2) spheno-occipital/clival ( 35%, base of skull), (3) vertebral (cervical thoracolumbar, 15%).

### **Chorea**

Involuntary, irregular, brief, non-repetitive jerky movements flowing randomly from one body part to another ('dance-like'), due to basal ganglia (striatal) dysfunction.

### **Chorioamnionitis**

Infection of the chorion and amnion, typically due to ascending bacterial infection from the genital tract. Risk factors include prolonged rupture of membranes, multiple vaginal exams, and preterm labor. Presents with maternal fever, uterine tenderness, and fetal tachycardia. Diagnosis is clinical; amniocentesis for confirmation.

### **Chorioamnionitis (Intraamniotic Infection)**

Infection or inflammation of the amniotic fluid, membranes, placenta, or decidua, usually due to ascending polymicrobial infection. Maternal fever, uterine tenderness, fetal tachycardia, and maternal leukocytosis may occur; treatment requires broad-spectrum antibiotics and delivery planning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Intraamniotic Infection

### **Choriocarcinoma**

Choriocarcinoma is an aggressive trophoblastic cancer producing human chorionic gonadotropin, usually arising after pregnancy or a molar pregnancy.

### **Chorion**

The outermost fetal membrane, derived from the trophoblast. The chorion frondosum (villous chorion) develops into the fetal portion of the placenta. The chorion laeve (smooth chorion) is the non-villous portion. Chorionic villi contain fetal blood vessels and are bathed in maternal blood.

### **Chorionic Villus Sampling**

Prenatal diagnostic test at 10-13 weeks gestation, earlier than amniocentesis. Transabdominal or tran-

scervical biopsy of chorionic villi (placental tissue). Indications: advanced maternal age, abnormal first-trimester screen, carrier screening, or family history of genetic disorders. Analyzed for karyotype, FISH, and microarray.

### **Chorioretinitis**

Inflammation involving the choroid and retina, often caused by infection, autoimmune disease, or systemic inflammatory illness. It can produce floaters and impaired vision.

### **Choroid**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as choroid. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Choroid Plexus Cyst**

A fluid-filled cyst within the choroid plexus of a fetal cerebral ventricle. An isolated cyst with otherwise reassuring prenatal assessment is usually benign, but its significance depends on other ultrasound findings and screening results.

### **Choroid Plexus Tumor**

A papillary neoplasm of the choroid plexus, occurring most often in children, and frequently presenting with hydrocephalus from excessive cerebrospinal fluid production.

### **Choroidal Neovascularization**

The pathological growth of new, fragile blood vessels from the choroid through Bruch membrane into the subretinal or sub-retinal pigment epithelium space, and it is the hallmark of wet age-related macular degeneration and the primary cause of severe central vision loss in this condition.

### **Christmas Disease**

Hemophilia B, an inherited bleeding disorder caused by deficiency or dysfunction of coagulation factor IX.

### **Chromaffinoma**

A tumor of chromaffin cells, usually a pheochro-

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mocytoma of the adrenal medulla or a related extra-adrenal paraganglioma. It may secrete catecholamines and cause episodic hypertension.

### **Chromatin**

The complex of DNA, histone proteins, and associated molecules that packages the genome in the nucleus. Its organization and chemical modification regulate DNA accessibility, replication, repair, and transcription.

### **Chromatopsia**

A visual disturbance in which objects appear abnormally colored. It may result from retinal disease, toxic exposure, medication effects, or other disorders of the visual system.

### **Chromhidrosis**

A rare condition in which sweat is abnormally colored, often yellow, green, blue, or black, because of pigment in the sweat glands or on the skin surface.

### **Chromoblastomycosis**

A chronic fungal infection of skin and subcutaneous tissue that produces slowly enlarging warty or scaly lesions, usually after traumatic implantation of the fungus.

### **Chromosomal Abnormality**

Change in chromosome number or structure. Numerical: aneuploidy (abnormal number, e.g., trisomy 21), polyploidy (extra sets). Structural: deletion, duplication, inversion, translocation.

### **Chromosome**

A chromosome is a DNA-protein structure carrying genetic information; humans normally have 46 chromosomes in most body cells.

### **Chronic**

A clinical condition or finding involving chronic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chronic Allograft Nephropathy**

Progressive transplant kidney function decline over months to years. Interstitial fibrosis and tubular atrophy on histology. Can be immunologic or non-immunologic. Optimize immunosuppression and manage risk factors including hypertension and recurrent disease.

### **Chronic Autoimmune Hashimoto Thyroiditis**

An autoimmune inflammatory disease of the thyroid that progressively destroys thyroid tissue and commonly causes hypothyroidism.

### **Chronic Autoimmune Thyroiditis**

Hashimoto thyroiditis, an autoimmune destruction of the thyroid that commonly causes hypothyroidism and may be associated with anti-thyroid antibodies.

### **Chronic Bronchitis**

Defined clinically as a productive cough for at least three months in each of two consecutive years, after excluding other causes. It is characterized by hypertrophy of mucus-secreting glands in the bronchi (Reid index > 0.5), goblet cell hyperplasia, and chronic airway inflammation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bronchitis Chronic (Chronic Bronchitis)

### **Chronic Caries**

Tooth decay that progresses slowly and may produce a firm, darkened lesion.

### **Chronic Cough**

Cough lasting > 8 weeks. Top 3 causes in non-smokers with normal CXR: upper airway cough syndrome, asthma, GERD. ACE inhibitor use is another common cause.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cough Chronic (Chronic Cough)

### **Chronic Eosinophilic Leukaemia**

A clonal myeloid neoplasm characterized by persistent eosinophilia, increased or dysplastic eosinophils,

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and evidence of an underlying clonal process or organ injury. Symptoms may include fatigue, fever, weight loss, rash, respiratory symptoms, splenomegaly, or cardiac and neurological complications.

### **Chronic Eosinophilic Pneumonia**

An idiopathic inflammatory lung disease characterized by eosinophilic infiltration of the pulmonary parenchyma, presenting with fever, cough, dyspnea, and peripheral airspace opacities on imaging.

### **Chronic Fatigue Syndrome**

A complex, debilitating disorder characterized by profound fatigue lasting >6 months that is not relieved by rest and is worsened by physical or mental exertion (post-exertional malaise). Associated symptoms: unrefreshing sleep, cognitive impairment (brain fog), orthostatic intolerance, joint pain, headaches, and sore throat.

#### **Synonyms:**

CFS (Chronic Fatigue Syndrome) SEID (Chronic Fatigue Syndrome)

### **Chronic Granulomatous Disease**

A primary immunodeficiency caused by defects in the NADPH oxidase complex in phagocytes (neutrophils, monocytes, macrophages), impairing the respiratory burst and killing of catalase-positive organisms.

### **Chronic Hypertension In Pregnancy**

Hypertension that predates pregnancy or is diagnosed early in pregnancy. It increases the risk of preeclampsia, fetal growth problems, preterm birth, and placental complications and requires ongoing maternal and fetal monitoring.

### **Chronic Inflammation**

A prolonged inflammatory response characterized by simultaneous tissue destruction and attempts at repair, lasting weeks to years. Unlike acute inflammation, it is predominantly mononuclear, involving macrophages, lymphocytes, and plasma cells rather than neutrophils.

### **Chronic Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyneuropathy**

An acquired, immune-mediated peripheral neuropathy with a relapsing-remitting or progressive course. Presents with symmetric proximal and distal weakness, sensory loss, areflexia, and elevated CSF protein. Distinguishing from Guillain-Barre: progressive course >8 weeks (vs. rapid onset in GBS).

### **Chronic Inflammatory Response Syndrome**

A proposed multisystem illness involving persistent inflammatory symptoms after an exposure such as certain water-damaged building environments. Reported symptoms are nonspecific and may include fatigue, headache, cognitive difficulty, and respiratory complaints. Symptoms require a careful medical evaluation for established infectious, allergic, toxic, autoimmune, and other causes.

### **Chronic Intestinal Pseudo-Obstruction**

Chronic condition of recurrent episodes of intestinal obstruction without mechanical blockage due to neuromuscular dysfunction of the gastrointestinal tract. May involve the small bowel, colon, or both. Causes include systemic sclerosis, diabetes, Parkinson disease, amyloidosis, and paraneoplastic syndromes.

### **Chronic Kidney Disease**

Chronic kidney disease is the progressive loss of kidney function over months to years, typically from diabetes, hypertension, or glomerular diseases. It is staged by estimated glomerular filtration rate and albuminuria, with end-stage renal disease requiring dialysis or transplantation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chronic Kidney Failure Chronic Renal Failure Kidney Disease, Chronic Kidney Failure, Chronic

### **Chronic Kidney Disease Staging**

Classification of kidney disease by cause, eGFR category, and albuminuria category. G1 through G5 represent eGFR from normal or high to kidney failure; staging is applied when abnormalities persist for at least 3 months and helps estimate progression



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and complications.

### **Chronic Lead Poisoning**

Prolonged low-level lead exposure causing abdominal pain, anemia with basophilic stippling, peripheral neuropathy, and nephropathy, requiring chelation therapy and removal of the exposure source.

### **Chronic Leukemia**

A leukemia characterized by an insidious onset, clonal proliferation of relatively mature blood cells, and a more indolent clinical course.

### **Chronic Limb-Threatening Ischemia**

The most severe clinical form of peripheral arterial disease, characterized by chronic ischemic rest pain, nonhealing ulceration, or gangrene attributable to arterial insufficiency. It carries high risks of limb loss and cardiovascular mortality and requires vascular evaluation for revascularization and wound management.

### **Chronic Liver Disease**

Persistent hepatic injury and structural change lasting at least 6 months, caused by viral, metabolic, alcohol-related, autoimmune, cholestatic, vascular, or drug-related disease. Progressive fibrosis can lead to cirrhosis, portal hypertension, liver failure, and hepatocellular carcinoma.

### **Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia**

The most common leukemia in Western countries, characterized by the clonal proliferation of mature-appearing but functionally incompetent B lymphocytes that accumulate in blood, bone marrow, and lymphoid tissues.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia CLL Leukemia, Chronic Lymphocytic

### **Chronic Mesenteric Ischemia**

Recurrent abdominal pain occurring after eating resulting from insufficient blood flow to meet the metabolic demands of the gastrointestinal tract. Most commonly caused by atherosclerotic stenosis of at least two of the three major mesenteric

arteries.

### **Chronic Migraine**

A migraine disorder with headache on at least 15 days per month for more than three months, with migraine features on at least eight days per month. Symptoms may include throbbing pain, nausea, vomiting, and light or sound sensitivity; frequent or disabling headaches require clinical evaluation.

### **Chronic Mucocutaneous Candidiasis**

Persistent/recurrent *Candida* infections of skin, nails, mucosa (oral, esophageal, vaginal) without systemic dissemination. Autosomal dominant (STAT1 gain-of-function) or recessive (IL17F, IL17RA, ACT1, RORC). Associated with autoimmunity (hypothyroidism, AIHA, ITP, alopecia), endocrinopathies, Staph infections.

### **Chronic Myelogenous Leukemia**

A myeloproliferative neoplasm associated with the BCR-ABL1 fusion gene, usually producing marked leukocytosis and splenomegaly.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Chronic Myelogenous Leukemia Leukemia, Chronic Myelogenous

### **Chronic Myeloid Leukemia**

A myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by the Philadelphia chromosome [t(9;22)(q34;q11.2)], which creates the BCR-ABL1 fusion gene encoding a constitutively active tyrosine kinase.

### **Chronic Myelomonocytic Leukemia**

A rare myelodysplastic/myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by persistent monocytosis (absolute monocyte count greater than 1,000 per microliter and greater than 10 percent of white blood cells) in the peripheral blood and bone marrow, with dysplastic features and variable blast count.

### **Chronic Neutrophilic Leukaemia**

A rare clonal myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by sustained mature neutrophilic leukocytosis without a primary infectious or inflammatory cause. It may cause fatigue, fever, weight loss,

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splenomegaly, and progressive constitutional symptoms.

### **Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease**

COPD is a preventable lung disease characterized by persistent respiratory symptoms and airflow limitation due to airway and/or alveolar abnormalities, usually caused by significant exposure to noxious particles or gases (primarily tobacco smoke). Includes emphysema and chronic bronchitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

COPD (Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease)

### **Chronic Pain**

Pain persisting longer than three months or beyond normal tissue healing time, often lacking an ongoing identifiable cause. It involves complex interactions between biological, psychological, and social factors that can amplify pain signaling in the nervous system.

### **Chronic Pain Management**

Chronic pain management extends beyond the perioperative period. Opioid therapy for chronic pain requires careful patient selection, informed consent, and regular reassessment.

### **Chronic Pancreatitis**

Progressive irreversible inflammatory condition characterized by permanent structural damage causing exocrine and endocrine impairment. The most common cause is chronic alcohol consumption. Other causes include hereditary pancreatitis, autoimmune pancreatitis, and metabolic factors.

### **Chronic Rhinitis**

Persistent inflammation or irritation of the nasal lining causing congestion, runny nose, sneezing, itching, or postnasal drainage. Allergic, nonallergic, medication-related, and structural causes are possible. Management depends on the cause and may include trigger avoidance, saline irrigation, and clinician-directed nasal treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Post-Nasal Drip (Chronic Rhinitis)

### **Chronic Rhinosinusitis**

Persistent inflammation of the nose and paranasal sinuses lasting at least 12 weeks, usually with nasal obstruction or discharge and sometimes facial pressure or reduced smell. It may occur with or without nasal polyps.

### **Chronic Sinusitis**

Persistent inflammation of the paranasal sinuses for at least 12 weeks, causing nasal obstruction, discharge, facial pressure, and reduced smell.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sinusitis, Chronic

### **Chronic Tension-Type Headache**

A recurring headache occurring on at least 15 days per month for more than three months, usually causing bilateral pressing or tightening pain rather than throbbing. It may be associated with scalp or neck tenderness but typically lacks prominent nausea; a new or changing pattern requires clinical assessment.

### **Chronic Thromboembolic Pulmonary Hypertension**

Pulmonary hypertension caused by organized, persistent thromboembolic obstruction and secondary pulmonary-vessel remodeling after pulmonary embolism. It is potentially curable in selected patients by pulmonary endarterectomy or balloon pulmonary angioplasty.

### **Chronic Toxicity**

Adverse effects from repeated or prolonged exposure to low doses. Cumulative damage may be irreversible. Examples: heavy metals (lead, mercury), asbestos, alcohol, solvent exposure. Monitoring: biomarkers, organ function tests.

### **Chronic Venous Disease**

A spectrum of venous outflow disorders caused by reflux, obstruction, or calf-muscle-pump dysfunction. Findings range from edema and varicose veins to skin changes, lipodermatosclerosis, and venous ulceration.

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### Chronic Venous Insufficiency

Impaired venous return from the lower extremities due to venous valve incompetence or obstruction. Leads to venous hypertension, edema, skin changes (lipodermatosclerosis, hyperpigmentation), and venous stasis ulcers (medial malleolus). Risk factors: varicose veins, DVT, obesity, prolonged standing.

### Chronic Venous Stasis

Persistent pooling of blood in the lower limbs caused by impaired venous return. It can produce edema, skin discoloration, dermatitis, and venous ulcers.

### Churg-Strauss Syndrome

Eosinophilic granulomatosis with polyangiitis, a necrotizing inflammation of small and medium blood vessels associated with asthma, eosinophilia, and possible injury to the lungs, nerves, skin, heart, or kidneys.

#### Synonyms:

Churg Strauss Syndrome (Churg-Strauss Syndrome)

### Chvostek Sign

A clinical sign of latent tetany caused by hypocalcemia (ionized  $\text{Ca}^{2+} < 4.4 \text{ mg/dL}$ ). Elicited by tapping the facial nerve over the parotid gland just anterior to the ear canal. Positive response: involuntary twitching or contraction of ipsilateral facial muscles (lip twitching or facial spasm).

### Chylangioma

A benign malformation or tumor-like lesion of lymphatic vessels containing chyle or lymph. It may occur in the neck, mediastinum, or other tissues.

### Chylomicron

Transports dietary lipids. Largest, least dense lipoprotein.

### Chylothorax

Pleural effusion with chyle from thoracic duct disruption. Triglycerides  $> 110 \text{ mg/dL}$ . Treatment includes dietary modification, octreotide, and surgical ligation if refractory.

### Chyluria

Passage of lymphatic fluid into the urine, giving it a milky appearance. It usually results from an abnormal communication between lymphatic vessels and the urinary tract.

### Ciclopia

A rare severe congenital malformation in which the eyes are fused or a single median eye develops, usually as part of holoprosencephaly.

### CIDP

Chronic inflammatory demyelinating polyneuropathy (CIDP) is a chronic, immune-mediated, peripheral neuropathy characterized by progressive or relapsing symmetrical weakness and sensory loss in all four limbs, with areflexia or hyporeflexia, lasting for more than eight weeks.

### Ciguatera

Food poisoning caused by eating reef fish containing ciguatoxins. It may cause gastrointestinal illness followed by neurologic symptoms such as paresthesias and temperature-sensation disturbance.

### Ciliary Body

Circumferential structure between iris and choroid, with ciliary muscle (accommodation control via zonular fibers) and ciliary processes (aqueous humor production). Part of the uveal tract (iris, ciliary body, choroid).

### Ciliopathy

A disorder caused by abnormal structure or function of cellular cilia. Ciliopathies may affect development, vision, kidney function, respiration, or multiple organ systems.

### Cineangiocardiology

Radiographic recording of the heart and blood vessels during passage of contrast material, used to visualize cardiac chambers, valves, and coronary or great vessels.

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### Cinefluorography

Motion-picture recording of fluoroscopic images, used to document movement of organs or contrast material during a diagnostic examination.

### Cineplasty

Surgical creation of a muscle-controlled stump or related reconstruction, historically used to improve control of a prosthetic limb.

### Cingulotomy

Surgical interruption of selected fibers of the cingulum, sometimes performed as a psychosurgical treatment for severe, treatment-resistant psychiatric illness or chronic pain.

### Circadian Rhythm

The approximately 24-hour endogenous biological cycle regulating sleep-wake behavior, hormone secretion, body temperature, metabolism, and other physiological processes. Generated by the suprachiasmatic nucleus of the hypothalamus, which is entrained to the environment primarily by light via the retinohypothalamic tract.

### Circle Of Willis

A ring-like arterial anastomosis at the base of the brain that provides collateral blood flow between the anterior (internal carotid) and posterior (vertebrobasilar) circulations. It is formed by the anterior cerebral, anterior communicating, internal carotid, posterior cerebral, and posterior communicating arteries.

### Circulating Tumor DNA

Fragments of tumor-derived DNA detectable in blood, enabling molecular profiling, treatment monitoring, and detection of minimal residual disease without tissue biopsy (liquid biopsy).

### Circumcision

A medical procedure involving circumcision. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure. medical reasons such as severe phimosis, recurrent balanoposthitis, paraphimosis, or lichen sclerosus (balanitis xerotica obliterans); elective infant circumcision for religious, cultural, or preventive health reasons.

### Circumflex Artery

A branch of the left coronary artery that travels in the left atrioventricular groove. It supplies the lateral wall of the left ventricle, the left atrium, and in left-dominant systems, the inferior wall and posteromedial papillary muscle.

### Cirrhosis

Cirrhosis is advanced liver scarring with regenerative nodules that distorts blood flow and liver function, potentially causing portal hypertension, jaundice, ascites, and liver failure. distortion of the hepatic architecture and formation of regenerative nodules. The most common causes include chronic hepatitis C infection, alcoholic liver disease, non-alcoholic steatohepatitis, chronic hepatitis B infection, and autoimmune hepatitis.

### Citrate Synthase

First enzyme of TCA cycle. Condenses oxaloacetate and acetyl-CoA to citrate.

### Citric Acid Cycle (Krebs Cycle)

A central metabolic pathway occurring in the mitochondrial matrix that oxidizes acetyl-CoA (derived from carbohydrates, lipids, and proteins) into CO<sub>2</sub>, generating 3 NADH, 1 FADH<sub>2</sub>, and 1 GTP (ATP) per turn. Rate-limiting enzyme: isocitrate dehydrogenase (inhibited by ATP and NADH; activated by ADP).

#### Synonyms:

Krebs Cycle

### CKD

Abbreviation for Chronic Kidney Disease: a progressive loss of kidney function over months to years, defined by a glomerular filtration rate (GFR) less than 60 mL/min/1.73m<sup>2</sup> or markers of kidney damage (albuminuria, haematuria, structural abnormalities) persisting for at least 3 months.

### CKD-Mineral Bone Disorder

Systemic disorder of mineral and bone metabolism

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in CKD. Includes calcium, phosphorus, PTH, and vitamin D abnormalities with vascular calcification and bone disease. Renal osteodystrophy encompasses osteitis fibrosa, osteomalacia, adynamic bone disease, and mixed uremic osteodystrophy.

### **Class IA Antiarrhythmics**

Sodium channel blockers that slow phase 0 depolarization and prolong the action potential duration and refractory period. Examples include quinidine, procainamide, and disopyramide. Used for atrial and ventricular arrhythmias. Quinidine can cause QT prolongation and torsades de pointes.

### **Class IB Antiarrhythmics**

Sodium channel blockers that shorten the action potential duration and are preferentially taken up by ischemic tissue. Examples include lidocaine and mexiletine. Lidocaine is used for ventricular tachycardia and ventricular fibrillation, particularly in the setting of acute myocardial infarction.

### **Class IC Antiarrhythmics**

Sodium channel blockers that significantly slow phase 0 depolarization without affecting action potential duration. Examples include flecainide and propafenone. Used for supraventricular arrhythmias in patients without structural heart disease.

### **Class III Antiarrhythmics**

Potassium channel blockers that prolong the action potential duration and refractory period. Examples include amiodarone, sotalol, dofetilide, and ibutilide. Amiodarone is the most commonly used but has significant toxicity. Sotalol has additional beta-blocking properties and can cause torsades de pointes.

### **Claudication**

Muscle pain or cramping brought on by exertion and relieved by rest, usually because of reduced arterial blood flow to a limb.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular Claudication

### **Claudication Distance**

The distance a person can walk before exertional limb pain begins. It is used to describe symptoms and monitor change.

### **Claustrophobia**

An intense fear of enclosed or confined spaces that may cause anxiety, panic, or avoidance. Symptoms can occur in places such as elevators, tunnels, or MRI scanners.

### **Clavicle**

Only horizontally oriented long bone, serving as a shoulder-trunk strut. Medial end articulates with the manubrium (sternoclavicular joint); lateral end with the acromion (acromioclavicular joint). Most common fracture at the middle-lateral third junction from falls on an outstretched hand.

### **Clavicle Fracture**

A break in the collarbone that may occur during birth or after trauma. A newborn may show asymmetric arm movement or tenderness; older children and adults may have pain, swelling, or deformity. Diagnosis is usually made by examination and imaging.

### **Clavicle Fracture (Intentional)**

Intentional fracture of the fetal clavicle as a last resort to reduce the bisacromial diameter in shoulder dystocia. The operator applies upward pressure on the midportion of the anterior fetal clavicle with a finger, fracturing it. The clavicle heals without long-term sequelae.

#### **Synonyms:**

Intentional

### **Claw Foot**

A deformity in which the toes are hyperextended at the metatarsophalangeal joints and flexed at the interphalangeal joints. It may result from muscle imbalance or neurologic disease.

### **Claw Hand**

A hand deformity with hyperextension at the



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metacarpophalangeal joints and flexion at the interphalangeal joints, classically caused by ulnar-nerve palsy or lower brachial-plexus injury.

### **Claw Toe**

A toe deformity characterized by extension at the metatarsophalangeal joint and flexion at the proximal and distal interphalangeal joints.

### **Clear Margins**

A histological finding indicating that no abnormal cells (e.g., cervical intraepithelial neoplasia or cancer cells) are present at the edge of a tissue specimen removed during a procedure such as LLETZ, cone biopsy, or surgical excision.

### **Clearance**

The volume of plasma from which a drug is completely removed per unit time, typically expressed in milliliters per minute or liters per hour. Total clearance is the sum of all clearance mechanisms, primarily hepatic and renal clearance.

### **Cleft Lip**

A congenital malformation: incomplete fusion of the lip (and often palate) during embryologic development, causing a facial cleft; cleft lip and/or cleft palate are the most common craniofacial birth defects.

### **Cleft Lip And Palate**

A congenital anomaly caused by failure of fusion of the facial prominences during embryonic development (4-10 weeks gestation). Cleft lip: failure of maxillary and medial nasal processes to fuse. Cleft palate: failure of palatal shelves to fuse. Can occur together or separately.

### **Cleft Palate**

A congenital malformation characterized by an opening (cleft) in the palate (roof of the mouth) due to failure of fusion of the palatal shelves during embryonic development (weeks 6–9 of gestation). Incidence: 1 in 1,500–2,500 live births. Cleft palate may occur in isolation or with cleft lip (cleft lip and palate—CLP).

### **Cleidocranial Dysplasia**

An inherited skeletal disorder characterized by defective development or ossification of the clavicles and skull, delayed closure of cranial sutures, dental abnormalities, and short stature.

### **Climacteric**

The period of physiologic change around the end of reproductive capacity, including the menopausal transition. It may involve changes in menstruation, vasomotor symptoms, and other endocrine effects.

### **Clinical Communication**

Exchange of information between healthcare professionals, patients, and caregivers to support diagnosis, treatment, safety, and informed decisions.

### **Clinical Counseling**

Guidance provided in healthcare to help patients make informed decisions about health, prevention, treatment, and self-management.

### **Clinical Depression**

A depressive disorder marked by persistent depressed mood or loss of interest with associated cognitive, emotional, or physical symptoms that cause clinically significant distress or impairment.

### **Clinical Deterioration**

Worsening of physiologic function or symptoms that increases risk of organ failure, disability, or death. Changes in mental status, respiratory effort, perfusion, urine output, and vital signs may precede overt collapse.

### **Clinical Documentation**

Recording of patient history, examination, assessment, treatment, and follow-up in the medical record.

### **Clinical Frailty Scale**

A clinician-rated scale that summarizes frailty from very fit to severely frail or terminally ill using activity, function, and disease burden. It supports communication and prognostic assessment but should



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be interpreted in the patient's clinical context.

### **Clinical Guideline**

Systematically developed statements to assist practice. Examples: CDC guidelines, WHO guidelines, specialty society guidelines.

### **Clinical Handover**

Transfer of responsibility and relevant patient information from one healthcare professional or team to another. Effective handover communicates diagnosis, current status, risks, pending tasks, contingency plans, and accountability.

### **Clinical Practice Guideline**

Evidence-informed recommendations intended to help healthcare professionals and patients make decisions about a specific clinical condition or situation.

### **Clinical Presentation**

Signs and symptoms of disease. Varies by disease, severity, patient factors.

### **Clinical Reasoning**

The cognitive process of collecting, weighting, and integrating clinical information to formulate diagnostic and management decisions. It includes problem representation, differential diagnosis, probability assessment, and recognition of cognitive bias.

### **Clinical Research**

Research involving people or human health data to study disease, diagnosis, prevention, treatment, or healthcare delivery.

### **Clinical Research Bias**

Systematic error in clinical study design or analysis, including selection bias, information bias, and confounding.

### **Clinical Trial**

A planned study in which people receive or are observed for an intervention to evaluate its safety, effects, or outcomes. Trials may be conducted in

phases and for many types of health interventions.

### **Clinical Trial Phases**

Stages used to study a medical intervention. Phase I primarily evaluates initial safety and dosing, Phase II evaluates preliminary efficacy and safety, Phase III compares treatment with standard care in larger groups, and Phase IV monitors use after approval.

### **Clinicopathologic Correlation**

Integration of clinical history, examination, imaging, laboratory data, and pathologic findings to reach a diagnosis. It is essential when tissue findings are limited, nonspecific, or potentially affected by sampling or artifact.

### **Clinodactyly**

A congenital or developmental lateral curvature of a finger or toe, most often affecting the fifth finger and resulting from abnormal shape of a phalanx.

### **Clinoid Process**

One of several bony projections of the sphenoid bone that form part of the cranial base and support structures around the optic canal and cavernous sinus.

### **Clip (Vascular)**

A small device used to close, occlude, or secure a blood vessel during a procedure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Clitoridectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the clitoris. In medicine it may be performed for selected tumors or severe disease; nonmedical removal is a harmful practice with no health benefit.

### **Clitoris**

A small, sensitive erectile organ located at the anterior junction of the labia minora, beneath the clitoral hood (prepuce). The clitoris is the primary source of female sexual pleasure and is homologous to the male penis.

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## Cloacal Exstrophy

The most severe congenital anomaly of the ventral abdominal wall, also called the OEIS complex (Omphalocele, Exstrophy of the bladder, Imperforate anus, Spinal defects). Incidence 1 in 200,000-400,000 births.

**Synonyms:**  
the OEIS.

## Cloacitis

Inflammation of a cloaca or cloacal region, particularly in disorders affecting the common terminal outlet of the urinary, genital, and intestinal tracts.

## Clonal Evolution

The selection and expansion of tumor-cell subclones with biologic or treatment-related advantages over time. It contributes to progression, metastasis, and acquired resistance to anticancer therapy.

## Clonic Seizure

A seizure characterized by rhythmic, repetitive jerking caused by recurrent involuntary muscle contractions. It may be focal or generalized, with or without impaired awareness, and is classified using the clinical pattern, electroencephalography, and the underlying cause.

## Clonorchiasis

Infection with the Chinese liver fluke, *Clonorchis sinensis*. It affects the biliary tract and may cause inflammation, obstruction, and long-term hepatobiliary complications.

## Clonus

A rhythmic, involuntary oscillation of a muscle (usually ankle or patellar) produced by sustained stretch, indicating upper motor neuron (UMN) disease—hyperreflexia. Elicited by rapid dorsiflexion of the foot (sustained clonus—5 or more beats) or tapping. Associated with spasticity, hyperreflexia, and UMN signs (Babinski).

## Closed Comedo

A small skin lesion formed when a follicular opening

is blocked by sebum and keratin but remains covered by the epidermis. It is commonly called a whitehead.

**Synonyms:**

a whitehead.

## Closed Fracture

A fracture in which the broken bone does not communicate through a wound with the external environment.

## Closed Reduction

Nonoperative realignment of a fractured or dislocated bone or joint by manipulation without surgically opening the site.

## Closed-Angle Glaucoma

Glaucoma caused by obstruction of the drainage angle of the anterior chamber, preventing aqueous humor outflow and producing potentially rapid elevation of intraocular pressure.

## Closed-Loop Insulin Delivery

Automated insulin delivery systems that combine continuous glucose monitoring with an insulin pump and control algorithm. The algorithm adjusts basal insulin delivery based on sensor glucose values in real time. Hybrid closed-loop systems require user-initiated meal boluses but automatically manage basal rates.

## Clostridioides Difficile

An anaerobic, spore-forming, toxin-producing gram-positive bacillus causing antibiotic-associated diarrhea and pseudomembranous colitis. Risk factors: antibiotics (especially clindamycin, fluoroquinolones, cephalosporins), hospitalization, age >65, PPIs, and immunosuppression. Toxins A and B damage colonic epithelium.

## Clostridioides Difficile Infection

An infectious diarrhea caused by the bacterium *Clostridioides difficile*, typically occurring after disruption of normal gastrointestinal flora by antibiotics. *C. difficile* produces toxins A and B that cause colonic inflammation and diarrhea. Risk factors include antibiotic exposure, proton pump inhibitor

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use, and advanced age.

### **Clostridioides Difficile Pathogenesis**

The mechanisms by which *C. difficile* causes disease. Antibiotic disruption of the normal gut flora allows the organism to colonize; its toxins injure the colonic mucosa and cause inflammation and diarrhea. Spores persist in the environment and facilitate transmission.

### **Clostridium**

A genus of anaerobic, usually spore-forming bacteria that includes species capable of causing diseases such as tetanus, botulism, gas gangrene, and antibiotic-associated colitis.

### **Clostridium Botulinum**

A gram-positive, spore-forming, anaerobic rod that produces botulinum toxin, the most potent toxin known. The toxin causes flaccid paralysis by blocking acetylcholine release at neuromuscular junctions. Infant botulism occurs from ingestion of spores in honey or soil. Wound botulism occurs from injection of contaminated heroin.

### **Clostridium Difficile**

*Clostridioides difficile* infection (CDI): a toxin-producing anaerobic gram-positive rod causing antibiotic-associated diarrhea and pseudomembranous colitis, most commonly after broad-spectrum antibiotics (clindamycin, cephalosporins, fluoroquinolones).

### **Clostridium Difficile Infection**

An anaerobic, spore-forming, toxin-producing gram-positive bacillus causing antibiotic-associated diarrhea and pseudomembranous colitis. See *Clostridioides difficile*.

### **Clostridium Perfringens**

A gram-positive, spore-forming, anaerobic rod that causes gas gangrene (clostridial myonecrosis) and food poisoning. The organism produces alpha-toxin, which causes tissue necrosis. Gas gangrene presents with crepitus, tissue necrosis, and systemic toxicity. Food poisoning presents with acute onset of diarrhea

and abdominal cramps.

### **Clostridium Tetani**

A gram-positive, spore-forming, anaerobic rod that causes tetanus. The organism produces tetanospasmin, a neurotoxin that causes spastic paralysis. Spores are found in soil and enter through wound contamination. The toxin blocks inhibitory neurotransmitters causing uncontrolled muscle contractions.

### **Clotting**

The cascade of enzymatic reactions converting circulating fibrinogen into an insoluble fibrin clot. See Blood Coagulation.

### **Clubbing**

Bulbous enlargement of the distal fingers or toes with increased nail curvature and loss of the normal nail-fold angle. It reflects proliferation of connective tissue in the distal digits and may be associated with chronic pulmonary disease, cyanotic heart disease, inflammatory bowel disease, or malignancy.

### **Clubfoot**

A clinical condition or finding involving clubfoot. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Clubfoot (Talipes Equinovarus)**

A congenital foot deformity with an incidence of approximately 1 in 1,000 live births, characterized by four components: equinus (ankle plantarflexion), varus (hindfoot inversion), adductus (forefoot adduction), and cavus (high arch).

#### **Synonyms:**

Talipes Equinovarus

### **Clubhand**

A congenital deformity of the hand in which the wrist and hand deviate toward the radial or ulnar side, often associated with deficiency or abnormal development of forearm bones.

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## Cluster Headache

A primary headache disorder causing severe one-sided orbital or periorbital pain in attacks lasting about 15–180 minutes, often with tearing, conjunctival redness, nasal symptoms, eyelid swelling, or facial sweating on the same side.

## Clutton's Joints

Painless bilateral swelling of the knees or other large joints associated with congenital syphilis, caused by chronic synovitis.

## CMV

Cytomegalovirus, a common herpesvirus that may cause mild or asymptomatic infection but can cause serious disease in fetuses and people with weakened immunity.

### Synonyms:

Cytomegalovirus (CMV)

## CMV Colitis

Colonic inflammation caused by cytomegalovirus reactivation in immunocompromised patients including those with HIV and organ transplant recipients. Presents with bloody diarrhea and abdominal pain. Diagnosed by colonoscopy with biopsy showing characteristic owl-eye intranuclear inclusions in enlarged cells.

## CO Poisoning

Toxicity from inhalation of carbon monoxide (CO), a colorless, odorless gas binding hemoglobin 200-300 times more avidly than oxygen, forming carboxy-hemoglobin (COHb) and reducing oxygen delivery. See carbon monoxide poisoning.

## Coagulation Cascade

The coagulation cascade is a series of enzymatic reactions leading to fibrin clot formation, involving serine protease activation cascades. The intrinsic pathway is initiated by contact activation when factor XII binds exposed collagen, sequentially activating factors XI, IX, and the cofactor VIII.

## Coagulation Factor Deficiencies

Inherited or acquired disorders in which one or more clotting factors are reduced or function abnormally, causing excessive bleeding. The clinical pattern and laboratory findings depend on the affected factor.

## Coagulation Profile

Panel of tests assessing the coagulation cascade. PT (prothrombin time, 11-14 sec): measures extrinsic and common pathways; elevated in vitamin K deficiency, warfarin, liver disease, DIC. INR standardizes PT for warfarin monitoring.

## Coagulative Necrosis

The most common form of necrosis, typically resulting from ischemic injury or infarction in most solid organs except the brain. The fundamental process involves denaturation of both structural proteins and enzymatic proteins, which prevents the immediate liquefaction of the dead tissue.

## Coagulopathy

A disorder of hemostasis that impairs normal clot formation or regulation and predisposes to abnormal bleeding or thrombosis. It may result from coagulation-factor deficiency, platelet dysfunction, anticoagulant exposure, liver disease, consumptive coagulopathy, or systemic illness.

## Coal Worker's Pneumoconiosis

Pneumoconiosis from coal dust. Simple CWP shows upper lobe macules. Complicated CWP (progressive massive fibrosis) involves coalescent macules. May be associated with Caplan syndrome.

## Coarctation

A localized narrowing of a tubular anatomical structure, especially coarctation of the aorta, which obstructs blood flow and produces characteristic pressure differences.

## Coarctation Of The Aorta

A congenital narrowing of the aorta, typically near the ductus arteriosus. Presents with upper extremity hypertension, diminished femoral pulses, and a blood pressure gradient between arms and legs.

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Associated with bicuspid aortic valve and other congenital heart defects.

### Coarse Crackles

Lower-pitched, longer-duration crackles heard throughout inspiration, caused by fluid or secretions in larger airways. They are heard in COPD, bronchiectasis, pneumonia, and pulmonary edema. They are less specific than fine crackles.

### Coats Disease

An uncommon retinal disorder characterized by abnormal retinal blood vessels, leakage, exudation, and sometimes retinal detachment, usually affecting one eye in childhood.

### Cobalamin Deficiency

Deficiency of vitamin B12 (cobalamin), a cofactor for methionine synthase (methylcobalamin) and methylmalonyl-CoA mutase (adenosylcobalamin).

### Cobalt-57

Calibration source for gamma cameras. Half-life 271 days. Used for quality control.

### Cobalt-Chromium

Base metal alloy for cast restorations. Strong, corrosion-resistant. Used for partial dentures, crowns.

### Cocaine Cardiotoxicity

Cocaine blocks norepinephrine and dopamine reuptake, causing sympathomimetic effects: tachycardia, hypertension, and coronary vasospasm. Acute myocardial infarction can occur even with normal coronary arteries due to vasospasm, accelerated atherosclerosis, and prothrombotic effects. Treatment: benzodiazepines for sympatholysis.

### Cocaine Toxicity

A toxic state caused by cocaine, often producing agitation, high blood pressure, rapid heart rate, hyperthermia, seizures, coronary vasospasm, myocardial infarction, or stroke. Treatment is supportive and may include sedation, temperature control, and

management of cardiovascular or neurologic complications.

### Coccidioidomycosis

A fungal infection caused by *Coccidioides* species, usually acquired by inhaling spores.

**Common name:** Valley fever

### Coccidiosis

Infection by coccidian protozoa. In humans it may cause intestinal disease or, in immunocompromised patients, infection of other organs.

### Coccydynia

Pain in the region of the coccyx, often worsened by sitting. Causes include trauma, childbirth, degenerative change, and less commonly infection or tumor.

**Synonyms:**

Pain Tailbone (Coccydynia)

### Coccygectomy

Surgical removal of the coccyx, reserved for selected cases of severe persistent coccygeal pain or a lesion that has not responded to conservative treatment.

### Coccyx

Terminal vertebral column part with 3-5 fused vertebrae. Articulates with the sacrum, allowing limited flexion important during childbirth. Provides attachment for gluteus maximus, coccygeus, and levator ani (pelvic floor). A common site of pain (coccydynia) following falls, direct trauma, and prolonged sitting.

### Cochlea

Snail-shaped hearing organ in the inner ear, coiled approximately 2.5 turns around the modiolus. Three fluid-filled chambers: scala vestibuli (perilymph), scala media (endolymph, organ of Corti), scala tympani (perilymph).

### Cochlear Implant

A cochlear implant is an electronic medical device that bypasses damaged or absent inner ear hair

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cells to provide direct electrical stimulation of the auditory nerve, restoring a perception of sound in individuals with severe to profound sensorineural hearing loss who derive limited benefit from hearing aids.

### Cockayne Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder of DNA repair characterized by progressive neurologic dysfunction, growth failure, developmental impairment, photosensitivity, and a prematurely aged appearance.

### Code Blue

A hospital emergency signal indicating that a person may be in cardiopulmonary arrest and requires immediate resuscitation response.

### Codman Triangle

A characteristic periosteal reaction seen on plain radiographs, formed when an aggressive bone lesion elevates the periosteum away from the bone cortex, creating a triangular area of new reactive bone at the angle between the raised periosteum and underlying cortex.

### Codon

Sequence of three nucleotides coding for one amino acid or stop signal. 64 possible codons: 61 code for amino acids, 3 are stop codons (UAA, UAG, UGA). Degeneracy: multiple codons code for same amino acid.

### Coenzyme

A non-protein organic molecule that binds to an enzyme (apoenzyme) and is required for its catalytic activity. Coenzymes often act as transient carriers of specific chemical groups or electrons.

### Coenzyme Q

A lipid-soluble molecule in mitochondrial membranes that transfers electrons during cellular energy production.

### Cofactor

A non-protein chemical compound or metallic ion re-

quired for an enzyme's catalytic activity. Cofactors include: (1) Metal ions ( $Mg^{2+}$ ,  $Zn^{2+}$ ,  $Fe^{2+}/Fe^{3+}$ ,  $Cu^{2+}$ ,  $Mn^{2+}$ ,  $Ca^{2+}$ , Mo, Se) that stabilize structure, participate in redox, or act as Lewis acids; (2) Coenzymes (organic cofactors, often vitamin-derived).

### Cogan's Syndrome

An autoimmune vasculitis characterized by interstitial keratitis and vestibular dysfunction including vertigo, hearing loss, and tinnitus. May involve large vessels including the aorta, causing aortic aneurysm or regurgitation. Treatment includes corticosteroids and immunosuppressive agents.

### Cognitive Behavioral Therapy

A structured, time-limited psychotherapy that identifies and modifies maladaptive thought patterns (cognitive distortions) and behaviors. It is based on the cognitive model that thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are interconnected. CBT uses techniques including cognitive restructuring, behavioral activation, exposure, and skills training.

### Cognitive Behavioral Therapy For Insomnia

Cognitive behavioral therapy for insomnia is a structured, evidence-based program that targets the thoughts and behaviors perpetuating poor sleep. Components include sleep restriction, stimulus control, cognitive restructuring, and sleep hygiene education.

### Cognitive Decline

A reduction over time in one or more cognitive abilities, such as memory, attention, language, reasoning, or visuospatial function.

### Cognitive Distortions

Systematic errors in thinking that perpetuate negative emotional states and maladaptive behaviors. Common distortions include all-or-nothing thinking, catastrophizing, mind reading, overgeneralization, emotional reasoning, and should statements. CBT focuses on identifying and modifying these patterns.



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## Cognitive Fitness

The active maintenance of mental sharpness and brain health through stimulating activities, physical exercise, social engagement, and proper nutrition. Regular challenges such as learning new skills, puzzles, reading, and social interaction support neuroplasticity and cognitive reserve.

## Cognitive Health And Memory

Cognitive health encompasses the ability to think clearly, learn, remember, and make decisions, with memory being a core component that involves encoding, storing, and retrieving information. Age-related changes in processing speed and recall are normal, but persistent decline may signal mild cognitive impairment or dementia.

## Cognitive Impairment

Decline in one or more cognitive domains: memory, attention, language, visuospatial, executive function. Types: subjective cognitive decline, mild cognitive impairment (MCI), dementia. MCI: functional independence preserved, impairment on testing. Dementia: functional impairment.

## Cognitive Rehabilitation

Structured therapy to improve cognitive function or help a person compensate for difficulties with memory, attention, language, or executive skills after illness or injury.

## Cognitive Screening

A brief assessment used to identify possible problems with memory, attention, language, or other cognitive functions. It does not by itself diagnose dementia or another disorder.

## Cohort Study

Follows exposed and unexposed groups over time. Prospective or retrospective. Measures incidence, relative risk.

## Coil (Vascular)

A catheter-delivered wire device used to block selected blood vessels, often to treat aneurysms or bleeding.

## Synonyms:

Vascular

## Coincidence Detection

Principle of PET imaging. Two 511 keV photons detected simultaneously (within nanoseconds) by opposing detectors. Line of response defined. Time-of-flight PET improves localization.

## Cold Abscess

An abscess that develops slowly with little heat, redness, or acute inflammation, classically in tuberculosis or other chronic infections.

## Cold Agglutinin

An antibody that causes red blood cells to agglutinate at relatively low temperatures. Pathologic cold agglutinins can cause autoimmune hemolytic anemia.

## Cold Agglutinin Disease

Autoimmune hemolytic anemia caused by IgM autoantibodies directed against the I/i antigens on RBC membranes (maximum reactivity at  $< 30^{\circ}\text{C}$ , optimal  $4^{\circ}\text{C}$ ).

## Cold Agglutinin Syndrome

An immune-mediated disorder in which antibodies react with red blood cells at low temperatures, potentially causing hemolytic anemia or circulation-related symptoms.

## Cold Agglutinins

IgM autoantibodies that bind red blood cell antigens at temperatures below 37 degrees Celsius, causing agglutination and potentially complement-mediated hemolysis in cooler peripheral circulation.

## Cold Injury

Tissue or systemic injury caused by exposure to low temperature, including hypothermia, frostbite, chilblains, and non-freezing cold injury. Severity depends on temperature, exposure duration, moisture, wind, and perfusion; affected patients require assessment for core-temperature disturbance and

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local tissue damage.

### **Cold Intolerance**

A clinical condition or finding involving cold intolerance. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cold Sore**

Herpes labialis: recurrent herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) infection of the lips/around mouth, presenting as prodromal tingling, then grouped vesicles that crust and heal in 7-14 days. Triggered by stress, fever, sunlight, immunosuppression, illness. Recurrence due to reactivation of latent virus in the trigeminal ganglion.

### **Colectomy**

Surgical resection of part or all of the colon. Right hemicolectomy: for cecal/ascending colon cancer. Left hemicolectomy: for descending/sigmoid cancer. Sigmoidectomy: for diverticulitis or sigmoid cancer. Total colectomy: for FAP, UC, or Lynch syndrome.

### **Colibacillosis**

Disease caused by pathogenic strains of *Escherichia coli*, which may produce intestinal infection, urinary-tract infection, sepsis, or other illness.

### **Colic**

Sudden, severe, often cramping pain caused by contraction or obstruction of a hollow organ. The term is also used for recurrent unexplained crying in an otherwise healthy infant.

### **Colitis**

Colitis is inflammation of the colon caused by infection, inflammatory bowel disease, reduced blood flow, medicines, radiation, or other injury.

### **Collagen**

The major structural protein of connective tissue, composed of three polypeptide chains arranged in a triple helix. Different collagen types provide tensile strength to skin, bone, cartilage, tendons, blood vessels, and basement membranes.

### **Collagen Disease**

A systemic disorder involving connective tissue and often immune-mediated injury to collagen-rich structures. The term has historically included diseases such as systemic lupus erythematosus and systemic sclerosis.

### **Collagen Implant**

Biocompatible scaffold for tissue engineering. Types: bovine, porcine, synthetic. Used for hernia repair, soft tissue augmentation.

### **Collagenous Colitis**

Chronic inflammatory bowel disease characterized by thickening of the subepithelial collagen band in the colonic mucosa to greater than ten micrometers normally less than five micrometers with preservation of the epithelial surface. Presents with chronic watery non-bloody diarrhea primarily in middle-aged women.

### **Collapsed Lung**

A common description of pneumothorax, in which air enters the pleural space and partially or completely collapses the lung. It may cause sudden chest pain and shortness of breath and can be life-threatening when tension develops. See also Pneumothorax.

### **Collateral Circulation**

Alternative vascular pathways that develop when coronary arteries become chronically narrowed. Collaterals connect different coronary artery territories and can partially compensate for stenosis. They develop gradually in response to ischemia and are more prominent in patients with chronic coronary artery disease.

### **Collateral Ligament Injury**

MCL (medial) or LCL (lateral) knee ligament injury. MCL more common, often from valgus stress. Treatment: braces, physical therapy, surgical repair if severe.

### **Collecting Duct**

Final segment of the nephron where fine-tuning of

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urine concentration and composition occurs. Principal cells respond to antidiuretic hormone by inserting aquaporin-2 water channels into the luminal membrane, enabling water reabsorption and urine concentration.

### **Colles Fracture**

A fracture of the distal radius with dorsal displacement and angulation of the distal fragment, usually caused by falling on an outstretched hand.

### **Collimator**

Lead device with holes to define gamma ray direction. Types: parallel-hole, pinhole, converging, diverging. Resolution vs. sensitivity trade-off.

### **Colloids**

Solutions containing large molecules that remain in the intravascular space, providing greater volume expansion per milliliter than crystalloids. Albumin (5 percent, 25 percent) is a natural plasma protein used for volume expansion and specific indications (cirrhosis with paracentesis, nephrotic syndrome).

### **Coloboma**

A congenital defect caused by failure of the optic fissure to close during embryonic development, resulting in a keyhole-shaped gap in any ocular structure including the iris, retina, choroid, or optic nerve. Iris colobomas are the most common and appear as a comma-shaped defect in the inferior iris.

### **Colocolonic Intussusception**

telescoping of a segment of colon into an adjacent segment, less common in adults than the ileocolic type and usually associated with a pathological lead point such as a polyp, tumor, or lipoma. Adults typically present with intermittent abdominal pain, bloating, and change in bowel habits.

### **Colon**

The largest part of the large intestine, extending from the cecum to the rectum. Anatomically divided into ascending colon (right side), transverse colon (across the abdomen), descending colon (left side), and sigmoid colon (S-shaped, leading to the rectum).

### **Colon Cancer**

Malignant neoplasm arising from the colonic epithelium, the third most common cancer worldwide and a leading cause of cancer-related mortality. Most arise from adenomatous polyps through the adenoma-carcinoma sequence over ten to fifteen years.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Colon Colorectal Cancer (Colon Cancer)

### **Colonic Ischemia**

Decreased blood flow to the colon causing mucosal or transmural injury. Most commonly affects watershed areas particularly the splenic flexure and rectosigmoid junction. Causes include non-occlusive hypoperfusion from cardiogenic shock, vasoconstrictive medications, and vasculitis.

### **Colonization**

Presence and multiplication of microorganisms on or in a body site without tissue invasion or clinical disease. Colonization may precede infection but does not by itself establish that symptoms are caused by the organism.

### **Colonoscopy**

Colonoscopy uses a flexible camera to examine the rectum and entire colon, allowing biopsy and removal of polyps or other lesions.

### **Colony-Forming Unit**

A unit used to estimate the number of viable microorganisms in a sample, derived from counting colonies grown on agar after plating a diluted sample. Each colony is assumed to arise from a single viable microorganism (or a cluster); results are reported as CFU/mL or CFU/g.

### **Color Blindness**

Reduced or absent ability to distinguish certain colors under normal lighting. It is often inherited, especially through X-linked variants, but may also result from eye disease, neurologic disease, aging, or medicines.

#### **Synonyms:**

Deficient Color Vision Poor Color Vision

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## Color Doppler

An ultrasound method that displays the direction and relative speed of blood flow in color over a grayscale image.

## Color Vision Deficiency

Color vision deficiency, commonly known as color blindness, is a condition in which the ability to perceive and discriminate certain colors is reduced or absent, most commonly affecting the perception of red and green hues, and it is caused by abnormalities in the cone photoreceptors responsible for color vision.

## Colorado Tick Fever

An acute viral infection transmitted by ticks and characterized by fever, headache, myalgia, and sometimes leukopenia or rash.

## Colorectal Adenocarcinoma

The third most common cancer worldwide and the second leading cause of cancer death, arising from the colonic epithelium through the adenoma-carcinoma sequence over 10 to 15 years. The pathogenesis involves sequential accumulation of genetic mutations beginning with APC loss, followed by KRAS activation, TP53 loss, and other alterations.

## Colorectal Cancer

A malignant tumor of the colon or rectum. It may cause bleeding, altered bowel habits, anemia, abdominal pain, or no early symptoms; evaluation and treatment depend on the tumor's location and stage.

## Colorectal Cancer Genetics

The study of inherited variants that increase the risk of colorectal cancer. Important inherited syndromes include Lynch syndrome, involving DNA mismatch-repair genes, and familial adenomatous polyposis, involving the APC gene.

## Colorectal Cancer Screening

Public health strategy to detect colorectal cancer and precancerous polyps in asymptomatic individuals. Current guidelines recommend screening begin-

ning at age forty-five.

## Colorectal Cancer Screening Tests

Tests used to detect colorectal cancer or precancerous polyps in people without symptoms. They include stool-based tests and examinations that visualize the colon, such as colonoscopy, CT colonography, and flexible sigmoidoscopy. The appropriate test and interval depend on age, risk, and local guidance.

## Colorectal Surgery

Surgical treatment of diseases of the colon, rectum, and anus. Procedures may include segmental bowel resection, restorative reconstruction, stoma formation, or local procedures, depending on the disease and its extent.

## Colostomy

A clinical condition or finding involving colostomy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Colostrum

The thick, yellowish fluid produced by the mammary glands in late pregnancy and the first few days postpartum. Rich in immunoglobulins (especially IgA), proteins, leukocytes, and growth factors.

## Colpitis

Inflammation of the vagina, often due to infection, altered vaginal flora, irritation, or hormonal change.

## Colposcopy

Magnified visualization of the cervix, vagina, and vulva after application of acetic acid. Indication: abnormal Pap smear (ASCUS with high-risk HPV, LSIL, HSIL, AGC). Acetic acid causes acetowhite lesions in dysplastic epithelium. Lugol iodine (Schiller test): normal glycogenated epithelium stains brown; abnormal epithelium does not.

## Coma

A state of profound unresponsiveness in which a person cannot be awakened and does not show pur-

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poseful responses. It is a medical emergency with many possible causes.

**Synonyms:**

Severe Brain Injury, Coma

**Coma Scale**

A standardized tool for describing level of consciousness using eye opening, verbal response, and motor response.

**Combination Inhalers**

Inhalers containing both an inhaled corticosteroid and a long-acting beta-2 agonist. Examples include fluticasone/salmeterol (Advair), budesonide/formoterol (Symbicort), and fluticasone furoate/vilanterol (Breo Ellipta). They simplify asthma and COPD maintenance therapy and improve adherence.

**Combination Therapy**

Use of two or more treatments together to address a disease or mechanism. The benefits and risks depend on the condition and the specific combination.

**Combined Spinal-Epidural Analgesia**

A neuraxial analgesia technique for labor that combines a spinal injection (short-acting opioid or opioid + low-dose local anesthetic) with an epidural catheter. Advantages: rapid onset of pain relief (3-5 minutes from the spinal component), minimal motor block, and the ability to dose through the epidural catheter for prolonged labor.

**Comedocarcinoma**

A form of ductal carcinoma in situ of the breast characterized by central necrosis within malignant ducts, which may produce a comedo-like appearance.

**Comfort Measures Only**

A care plan focused on relief of pain, breathlessness, distress, and other symptoms rather than treatments intended to prolong life.

**Comminuted**

Describing a fracture in which a bone is broken into

multiple fragments.

**Comminuted Fracture**

A fracture in which the bone is broken into three or more fragments. It may result from high-energy trauma and can be associated with soft-tissue injury, instability, and impaired healing.

**Commissurotomy**

Surgical incision or separation of a commissure, especially a fused cardiac valve commissure, to relieve obstruction.

**Commode**

A portable toilet or chair placed near a bed for a person who cannot easily reach a bathroom.

**Common Bile Duct**

The duct formed by union of the common hepatic and cystic ducts. It conveys bile to the duodenum, usually joining the pancreatic duct at the hepatopancreatic ampulla.

**Common Cold**

An acute, self-limited viral infection of the upper respiratory tract, one of the most frequent illnesses in humans, with adults experiencing 2-4 episodes annually and children 6-8 episodes.

**Synonyms:**

Cold, Common Cold (Common Cold)

**Common Iliac Arteries**

Terminal abdominal aortic branches at L4, each approximately 4 cm long, dividing into internal and external iliac arteries. They supply the pelvis and lower extremities. The right common iliac artery crosses anterior to the right common iliac vein.

**Common Peroneal Nerve**

Sciatic division (L4-S2) winding around the fibular neck, the body's most vulnerable major nerve to external compression. Divides into superficial peroneal (peroneus longus/brevis, dorsal foot sensation) and deep peroneal (tibialis anterior, extensors, first web space sensation).

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### **Common Peroneal Neuropathy**

A peripheral nerve disorder causing weakness of ankle dorsiflexion and eversion, sensory loss over the anterolateral leg and dorsum of the foot, and possible foot drop.

### **Common Variable Immunodeficiency**

The most common symptomatic primary immunodeficiency in adults, affecting approximately 1 in 25,000 individuals. It is characterized by hypogammaglobulinemia (low IgG with low IgA and/or IgM), impaired antibody response to vaccines, and increased susceptibility to infections.

### **Common Wart**

A benign epidermal proliferation caused by human papillomavirus, presenting as a rough hyperkeratotic papule, commonly on the hands or fingers.

### **Commotio Cordis**

Sudden cardiac arrest caused by a blunt, nonpenetrating impact to the chest at a vulnerable moment in the cardiac cycle, without structural heart injury.

### **Communicable Disease**

Any disease caused by bacteria, viruses, or other pathogens that is spread from person to person.

### **Communicating Hydrocephalus**

A type of hydrocephalus in which there is free flow of cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) between the ventricles, but impaired absorption of CSF at the arachnoid granulations or increased CSF production. The ventricles are uniformly dilated, including the fourth ventricle.

### **Community Acquired Infection**

An infection present or incubating at hospital admission, or developing within 48 hours of admission without recent healthcare exposure. Common examples include pneumonia, urinary tract infection, and meningitis caused by organisms such as *Streptococcus pneumoniae* and *Escherichia coli*, generally susceptible to narrow-spectrum antibiotics.

### **Community Health Worker**

A trained member of a community who helps connect people with health services, education, prevention, and social support.

### **Community Rehabilitation**

Rehabilitation delivered in community settings to improve a person's participation, independence, and daily functioning.

### **Community Reintegration**

Return to community roles: work, leisure, social. Vocational rehabilitation, accessibility modifications.

### **Community-Acquired**

Acquired outside a healthcare facility or before a person has been exposed to healthcare-associated conditions.

### **Community-Acquired Pneumonia**

CAP: acquired outside hospital. CURB-65 (confusion, uremia  $>7$ , respiratory rate  $\geq 30$ , BP  $<90/60$ , age  $\geq 65$ ) and PSI/PORT score for severity/site of care. Outpatient: amoxicillin 1g TID, doxycycline 100 mg BID, or macrolide (if resistance  $<25$  percent); respiratory fluoroquinolone (levofloxacin, moxifloxacin) as alternative.

### **Comorbidity**

Presence of two or more chronic conditions in same individual. Common in elderly: hypertension, diabetes, arthritis, COPD, depression. Increases complexity of care, polypharmacy risk, functional decline. Comprehensive assessment needed for each condition and interactions.

### **Comparison**

A reference in an imaging report to earlier studies used to assess whether a finding has changed.

### **Compartment Pressure**

The pressure within a closed osteofascial compartment. Markedly elevated pressure can impair capillary perfusion and cause acute compartment syn-



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drome; pressure measurements support but do not replace clinical assessment.

### Compartment Syndrome

A surgical emergency caused by increased pressure within a closed osteofascial compartment, leading to tissue ischemia, necrosis, and permanent functional loss. The lower leg (anterior, lateral, deep posterior, and superficial posterior compartments) and forearm (flexor and extensor compartments) are the most commonly affected sites.

#### Synonyms:

Syndrome Compartment (Compartment Syndrome)

### Competence

Autonomous voluntary authorization given by a competent patient to undergo a specific medical intervention, procedure, or clinical trial. See informed consent.

### Competitive Antagonist

A competitive antagonist is a drug that binds to the same receptor site as an agonist and competes for binding, reducing the effect of the agonist without producing an effect of its own.

### Competitive Inhibition

A type of enzyme inhibition where the inhibitor (I) competes with the substrate (S) for binding to the enzyme's active site. The inhibitor structurally resembles the substrate and binds reversibly to the free enzyme (E), forming an EI complex that cannot proceed to product.

### Complement C1Q Deficiency

Autosomal recessive (C1QA, C1QB, C1QC). C1q essential for classical pathway activation and immune complex clearance. 85-90% develop SLE-like disease (malar rash, photosensitivity, nephritis, anti-nuclear antibodies). Recurrent infections with encapsulated bacteria. Low CH50, low C1q, normal C3/C4.

### Complement C2/C4 Deficiency

C2 deficiency: most common early complement deficiency (1:20,000 Caucasians). SLE-like disease (10-30%), recurrent sinopulmonary infections. C4 defi-

ciency: similar, strong SLE association (C4A/C4B null alleles). Low CH50, low C2 or C4, normal C3. Treatment: SLE management, prophylactic antibiotics, IVIG for recurrent infections.

### Complement C3

The central complement component cleaved into C3a and C3b during activation of the classical, lectin, or alternative pathway. C3b promotes opsonization and formation of downstream convertases; severe C3 deficiency causes recurrent severe infections, especially with encapsulated bacteria.

### Complement Cascade

The ordered activation of 30 serum and membrane proteins (complement) that opsonize pathogens, lyse microbes (membrane attack complex), and promote inflammation.

### Complement Deficiencies

Rare primary immunodeficiencies caused by genetic defects in complement pathway proteins, increasing susceptibility to specific infections and autoimmune diseases.

### Complete Blood Count

A panel measuring red blood cells, white blood cells, platelets, hemoglobin, hematocrit, red-cell indices, and often a white-cell differential. Results are interpreted using age-, sex-, and laboratory-specific reference ranges.

### Complete Denture

Removable prosthesis replacing all teeth in arch. Maxillary and mandibular. Stability challenging in edentulous patients.

### Complete Response

Disappearance of all detectable signs of a cancer after treatment. It does not necessarily mean that every cancer cell has been eliminated.

### Complex Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates made up of longer chains of sugars, chiefly starches and dietary fiber, found in foods

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such as whole grains, legumes, vegetables, and potatoes. Fiber is not fully digested and supports bowel function, satiety, and metabolic health, while starch is digested into glucose at a rate that depends on food structure and processing.

### **Complex Regional Pain Syndrome**

A chronic pain condition characterized by regional pain and sensory changes disproportionate to the inciting event. Type I (reflex sympathetic dystrophy): no identifiable nerve injury. Type II (causalgia): follows a major nerve injury.

### **Compliance**

The extent to which a person follows a treatment recommendation; adherence is generally preferred because it emphasizes an agreed plan.

### **Complicated Grief**

Persistent, intense grief that substantially interferes with daily functioning and lasts longer than expected for the person's cultural and social context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Complicated Bereavement Traumatic Grief

### **Complicated Urinary Tract Infection**

A urinary infection associated with functional or structural abnormality, obstruction, catheterization, renal impairment, male anatomy, pregnancy, or another factor increasing treatment failure or complication risk. Management requires culture-directed therapy and correction of the underlying problem when possible.

### **Complication**

Any adverse event arising during or after a surgical procedure, graded by the Clavien-Dindo classification from minor deviation (Grade I) through organ failure (Grade IV) to death (Grade V). Common types include surgical site infection, hemorrhage, wound dehiscence, anastomotic leak, ileus, and venous thromboembolism.

### **Complications (Vascular)**

Post-procedural issues: bleeding, infection, thrombosis, embolism, limb ischemia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Composite Resin**

Tooth-colored restorative material. Bis-GMA or UDMA resin matrix with silica filler. Adhesive bonding. Esthetic but less durable than ceramic.

### **Compound Presentation**

A fetal presentation where an extremity (hand, arm, foot) presents alongside the vertex or breech. Most common: hand alongside the head. Incidence: 1:300-1:1000. Fetal prognosis is generally good; the prolapsed extremity often retracts as labor progresses. Management: expectant management in most cases.

### **Compounding**

Preparation, mixing, or altering of a medicine to meet an individual patient's needs when an appropriate approved product is unavailable.

### **Comprehensive Geriatric Assessment**

A multidimensional assessment of an older person's medical conditions, medicines, function, cognition, mood, and social support, used to develop an individualized care plan.

### **Comprehensive Metabolic Panel**

Extended version of BMP including albumin, total protein, alkaline phosphatase, ALT, AST, and bilirubin (total and direct). Evaluates liver function, kidney function, electrolytes, glucose, calcium, and protein status. Uses: preoperative assessment, medication monitoring, and liver/kidney disease evaluation.

### **Compression Therapy**

Use of external pressure, usually from garments or bandages, to support venous or lymphatic flow and reduce swelling in selected conditions.

### **Compression Ultrasound**

An ultrasound technique in which gentle pressure is applied to assess whether a vein collapses. Failure of a vein to compress may suggest thrombosis.

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### Compressive Atelectasis

Atelectasis caused by external compression of the lung by pleural fluid, air, or a mass. The lung volume is reduced by the external force. It is reversible when the compressing force is relieved (e.g., drainage of pleural effusion).

### Compton Scattering

An interaction in which a photon transfers part of its energy to an electron and changes direction. It contributes to scattered radiation in imaging.

### Compulsions

Repetitive behaviors or mental acts that the individual feels driven to perform in response to an obsession or according to rigid rules. They are aimed at preventing or reducing anxiety or preventing some dreaded event, but are not connected in a realistic way with what they are designed to neutralize.

### Computed Tomography

Cross-sectional imaging using rotating X-ray tube and detectors. Produces axial images, reconstructable into sagittal, coronal, 3D. CT number measured in Hounsfield units (HU): water = 0, air = -1000, bone = +1000. Contrast: iodine-based, enhances vascular structures and perfused organs. Speed: seconds.

### Computed Tomography Scan

Cross-sectional imaging using X-rays and computer processing. Emergency uses: head trauma (hemorrhage, fracture), chest (pulmonary embolism, aortic dissection), abdomen (appendicitis, bowel obstruction), CT pulmonary angiography (CTPA), CT angiography (CTA). Fast, widely available, high sensitivity for acute conditions.

### Concato's Disease

A historical term for primary polycythemia, now generally called polycythemia vera, a myeloproliferative neoplasm causing increased red-cell mass and often elevated blood viscosity.

### Concealed Pregnancy

Pregnancy that is hidden or not recognized until

delivery, often by denial (psychogenic) or deliberate concealment; a medicolegal concept relevant to infanticide.

### Concentration

Amount of substance per unit volume. Units: mg/dL, mmol/L, mEq/L, ppm. Conversion: molecular weight needed. Critical for toxicity assessment.

### Conception (Fertilization)

The fusion of a sperm and an ovum in the ampulla of the fallopian tube, forming a zygote. The sperm penetrates the corona radiata and zona pellucida (acrosome reaction). After fertilization, the zygote undergoes cleavage (mitotic division) as it travels toward the uterus. Implantation occurs approximately 6-10 days after ovulation.

#### Synonyms:

Fertilization

### Conchae

Curved bony structures covered by mucosa inside the nasal cavity that warm, humidify, and filter inhaled air.

### Conclusion

The part of a report that summarizes the main findings and their clinical significance or recommended next steps.

### Concomitant

A clinical condition or finding involving concomitant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Concordance

Probability both twins have same trait. Monozygotic (identical) twins > dizygotic (fraternal) for genetic traits. High concordance suggests genetic influence.

### Concrescence

Union of adjacent teeth by cementum only. Usually posterior teeth.

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### Concretio Cordis

Abnormal adhesion or fusion of structures within or around the heart, including adhesion of the pericardial surfaces or fusion of cardiac components.

### Concussion

A form of mild traumatic brain injury caused by a biomechanical force (direct blow to the head, face, neck, or elsewhere on the body with impulsive force transmitted to the head), resulting in a transient disturbance of brain function without structural damage visible on conventional neuroimaging.

### Condition

A general term for a state of bodily health or, in medical usage, a specific deviation from normal in structure or function that may or may not constitute a disease, including complaints lacking a discrete pathologic basis and overt diagnoses.

### Conduct Disorder

A childhood or adolescent disorder involving a persistent pattern of behavior that violates the rights of others or major age-appropriate rules. Examples include aggression, property destruction, deceitfulness, theft, and serious rule violations.

### Conduction Deafness

Hearing loss caused by impaired transmission of sound through the external or middle ear, with the inner ear and neural auditory pathways relatively preserved.

### Conductive Deafness

Hearing loss resulting from a problem in the external auditory canal, tympanic membrane, or middle ear that reduces conduction of sound to the inner ear.

### Conductive Hearing Loss

Hearing loss caused by impaired transmission of sound through the outer or middle ear. Audiometry commonly shows an air-bone gap, and causes include earwax, middle-ear fluid, perforation, otosclerosis, and ossicular disease.

### Condylar Process

The rounded articular projection of a bone, especially the mandibular process that articulates with the temporal bone to form the temporomandibular joint.

### Condyloma Acuminata

Soft, wart-like genital or perianal growths caused by certain human papillomavirus types.

### Condyloma Acuminatum

A benign, exophytic, papillomatous growth of the anogenital skin caused by human papillomavirus, most commonly types 6 and 11. They present as soft, flesh-colored, verrucous papules or plaques in the genital and perianal region. Condylomata are sexually transmitted and may be associated with cervical dysplasia.

### Condyloma Latum

Mucocutaneous lesion of secondary syphilis caused by *Treponema pallidum*, distinct from condyloma acuminata (genital wart).

### Condylomata Lata

Broad, flat, moist, grayish-white papules occurring in secondary syphilis, typically found in the anogenital region and other intertriginous areas. They are highly infectious and contain abundant *Treponema pallidum* organisms. Diagnosis is by darkfield microscopy or serological testing for syphilis.

### Cone-Beam Computed Tomography

Three-dimensional dental imaging using a cone-shaped X-ray beam and a rotating detector. It provides high-resolution views of teeth and maxillofacial bone with generally less radiation than conventional medical CT, but should be used only when the additional information affects care.

### Confabulation

Production of false or inaccurate statements or memories without conscious intent to deceive, often associated with memory impairment or frontal-lobe dysfunction.

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## Confidentiality

The ethical and legal duty of healthcare professionals to protect patient information from unauthorized disclosure. Founded on the principle of respect for patient autonomy and trust, confidentiality is a core requirement of medical ethics (GMC guidelines) and law (GDPR, Data Protection Act, Caldicott principles).

## Confirmatory Test

A test used to verify a preliminary or screening result, often with a different method or greater specificity. Confirmation should be selected according to the condition, specimen, timing, and accepted clinical guidelines.

## Confounding

Distortion of association by third variable. Examples: age confounding relationship between exposure and disease. Controlled by matching, stratification, regression.

## Confusion (Delirium)

Acute onset fluctuating disturbance in attention and awareness. Usually reversible. Precipitants: infection, medications, metabolic derangement, pain, constipation, urinary retention. Differentiate from dementia (chronic, progressive). Treatment: identify and treat underlying cause, environmental modification, avoid anticholinergics.

### Synonyms:

Delirium

## Confusion Assessment Method

A standardized bedside algorithm for detecting delirium. It identifies acute or fluctuating change, inattention, disorganized thinking, and altered level of consciousness; delirium requires the first two features plus either of the latter two.

## Congenital Adrenal Hyperplasia

Group of autosomal recessive disorders caused by enzyme deficiencies in the adrenal steroidogenesis pathway. Twenty-one hydroxylase deficiency is the most common accounting for approximately ninety-five percent of cases.

## Congenital Cataract

Opacification of the crystalline lens present at birth, a leading cause of treatable childhood blindness worldwide.

## Congenital CMV

Cytomegalovirus infection acquired in utero, the most common congenital viral infection. Maternal primary infection poses highest risk of fetal transmission and disease. Can cause microcephaly, sensorineural hearing loss, chorioretinitis, hepatosplenomegaly, and petechiae. Diagnosis by CMV PCR in urine or saliva.

## Congenital Contractural Arachnodactyly

An inherited connective-tissue disorder characterized by long slender fingers and toes, congenital flexion contractures, muscular hypoplasia, and sometimes kyphoscoliosis.

## Congenital Cytomegalovirus Infection

Cytomegalovirus infection acquired before birth. It may cause hearing loss, developmental problems, microcephaly, or no symptoms.

## Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia

A defect in the diaphragm allowing abdominal organs to herniate into the thoracic cavity, causing pulmonary hypoplasia and respiratory distress at birth. Most commonly a posterolateral (Bochdalek) defect on the left side. Presents with cyanosis, scaphoid abdomen, and bowel sounds in the chest.

## Congenital Disorder

A medical condition or structural abnormality present in an individual from birth, which may be caused by genetic factors or environmental influences in the womb.

## Congenital Glaucoma

A rare form of glaucoma (1 in 10,000-20,000 births) caused by developmental anomalies of the trabecular meshwork and anterior chamber angle, impairing aqueous humor outflow. Most cases are sporadic; familial forms are autosomal recessive (CYP1B1 gene mutations).



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### **Congenital Heart Disease**

Structural or functional abnormalities of the heart or great vessels present at birth. Examples include septal defects, patent ductus arteriosus, tetralogy of Fallot, transposition of the great arteries, coarctation of the aorta, and hypoplastic left-heart syndrome.

### **Congenital Heart Murmur**

A heart murmur heard in a newborn or infant. It may be innocent or may indicate a structural heart defect; assessment considers the murmur's characteristics and associated symptoms or examination findings.

### **Congenital Hip Dislocation**

Abnormal development or displacement of the hip joint present at birth or developing in infancy, now generally called developmental dysplasia of the hip.

### **Congenital Hyperinsulinism**

Condition of inappropriate insulin secretion in neonates and infants causing severe hypoglycemia. Most commonly caused by mutations in the KATP channel genes ABCC8 and KCNJ11. Histologically classified into focal and diffuse forms. Presents with severe symptomatic hypoglycemia in the first days of life.

### **Congenital Hyperthyroidism**

Thyrotoxicosis present at birth most commonly caused by maternal Graves disease with transplacental passage of thyroid-stimulating immunoglobulins. Presents with tachycardia, irritability, poor feeding, weight loss, and goiter. Transient neonatal hyperthyroidism resolves as maternal antibodies are cleared over weeks to months.

### **Congenital Hypothyroidism**

Thyroid hormone deficiency present at birth occurring in approximately one in two thousand to four thousand live births. Most common cause is thyroid dysgenesis including aplasia, ectopia, and hypoplasia. Universal newborn screening with TSH or T4 allows early detection and treatment preventing intellectual disability.

### **Congenital Megacolon**

Hirschsprung disease, a congenital absence of enteric ganglion cells in a segment of the bowel that causes functional obstruction and enlargement of the proximal colon.

### **Congenital Melanocytic Nevus**

A melanocytic nevus present at birth or appearing within the first few weeks of life, ranging from small (< 1.5 cm) to giant lesions covering large body surface areas. It results from proliferation of melanocytes during embryonic development and carries a small but important risk of melanoma, which is higher in larger lesions.

### **Congenital Nevus**

A melanocytic mole present at birth or developing soon afterward. It is composed of melanocytes in the epidermis and dermis. Size, location, and changes over time determine the need for clinical assessment and surveillance.

### **Congenital Pneumonia**

Lung infection acquired in utero, often from ascending chorioamnionitis. Presents with respiratory distress, fever or hypothermia, and sepsis. Common organisms include Group B Streptococcus, *E. coli*, and Ureaplasma. Diagnosis by chest X-ray showing infiltrates and blood culture.

### **Congenital Rubella Syndrome**

Fetal infection with rubella virus, particularly dangerous in the first trimester. Classic triad: congenital heart disease (patent ductus arteriosus, pulmonary stenosis), cataracts, and sensorineural hearing loss. Also causes hepatosplenomegaly, thrombocytopenia, and blueberry muffin rash.

### **Congenital Scoliosis**

A lateral curvature of the spine caused by congenital vertebral anomalies that arise during embryogenesis (failure of formation or segmentation). Failure of formation: hemivertebra (wedge-shaped vertebra causing progressive curvature). Failure of segmentation: unilateral unsegmented bar (block of bone on one side).



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## **Congenital Syphilis**

*Treponema pallidum* infection acquired transplacentally. Can cause stillbirth, prematurity, hepatosplenomegaly, rash, snuffles, osteochondritis, and Hutchinson teeth. Diagnosed by darkfield microscopy, VDRL/RPR in neonatal serum, or PCR.

## **Congenital Zika Syndrome**

Fetal brain infection with Zika virus, causing microcephaly, brain abnormalities, eye defects, hearing loss, and limb contractures. Transmission occurs via mosquito bite or sexual contact. Diagnosis by Zika virus PCR in maternal serum or amniotic fluid. No specific treatment. Prevention by avoiding endemic areas during pregnancy.

## **Congestion**

A passive vascular phenomenon of engorgement of a tissue or organ with blood from impaired venous or lymphatic drainage. Chronic venous congestion produces stasis, hypoxia, dilated vessels, edema, hemorrhage, and hemosiderin-laden macrophages, exemplified by the lungs (heart failure cells) and liver (nutmeg liver).

## **Congestive Heart Failure**

A historical term for heart failure with clinical fluid congestion. Current terminology is heart failure, which may occur with or without congestion and is classified by left-ventricular ejection fraction, symptoms, and disease stage.

## **Conization**

Surgical removal of a cone-shaped portion of the cervix for diagnosis or treatment of cervical dysplasia or selected early cervical cancers.

## **Conjoined Twins**

Monozygotic, monochorionic, monoamniotic twins who are physically connected at birth, resulting from incomplete fission of the fertilized ovum after day 13 of fertilization. Incidence: 1 in 50,000-100,000 births.

## **Conjunctiva**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as

conjunctiva. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease. the eyelids (palpebral conjunctiva) and covers the anterior surface of the sclera (bulbar conjunctiva), forming a continuous sheet that protects the eye and facilitates smooth eyelid movement.

## **Conjunctival Squamous-Cell Carcinoma**

A malignant tumor of the conjunctival epithelium, typically arising from the limbal area. It is associated with UV radiation exposure and can invade locally if not treated promptly.

## **Conjunctivitis**

Inflammation of the conjunctiva, the thin, transparent mucous membrane lining the inner surface of the eyelids and the anterior surface of the sclera. Conjunctivitis is the most common cause of red eye and is classified by etiology.

## **Conjunctivoplasty**

Plastic or reconstructive surgery of the conjunctiva, performed to repair defects, scarring, adhesions, or other abnormalities of the ocular surface.

## **Conn's Syndrome**

Primary hyperaldosteronism caused by autonomous secretion of aldosterone, leading to hypertension and often low serum potassium.

## **Connective Tissue**

A diverse type of tissue that supports, binds, protects, and insulates organs and structures throughout the body.

## **Connective Tissue Disease**

Autoimmune diseases affecting connective tissue. Examples: SLE, scleroderma, RA, Sjogren syndrome, mixed connective tissue disease. Overlap syndromes common.

## **Conscious Sedation**

A drug-induced depression of consciousness in which patients respond purposefully to verbal or tactile stimulation, maintain a patent airway, and retain

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protective reflexes. Typical agents include midazolam, fentanyl, or low-dose propofol. Indications include endoscopic and minor surgical procedures.

### **Consolidation**

An area of lung in which air spaces are filled with fluid, cells, or other material, increasing its density on imaging. Causes include pneumonia, edema, hemorrhage, and tumor.

### **Consolidation Therapy**

Additional treatment given after remission to eliminate residual disease and reduce the risk of relapse.

### **Constipation**

Infrequent or difficult passage of stools, often with hard stools, straining, incomplete evacuation, or a sensation of blockage. Causes include diet, medicines, functional disorders, and structural or systemic disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Constipation Home Remedies (Constipation)

### **Constitutional Delay In Puberty**

A normal variant in which pubertal development is delayed but eventually progresses normally; growth and bone age are typically delayed.

### **Constraint-Induced Movement Therapy**

Rehabilitation that limits use of a less-affected limb while providing structured practice with an affected limb to improve functional use in selected people.

### **Constrictive Pericarditis**

Thickening and fibrosis of the pericardium restricting diastolic ventricular filling. Presents with jugular venous distension, peripheral edema, hepatomegaly, and Kussmaul sign. Causes include idiopathic, post-viral, radiation, and tuberculosis. Pericardiectomy is the definitive treatment.

### **Consultation-Liaison Psychiatry**

The subspecialty of psychiatry focused on the interface between psychiatry and general medical illness. Psychiatrists provide consultation on medical-

surgical wards for patients with psychiatric symptoms arising from or coexisting with medical conditions.

### **Contact Allergen Testing**

Patch testing identifies allergens causing allergic contact dermatitis. Standard panel includes 35 common allergens (nickel, fragrance mix, balsam of Peru, formaldehyde, rubber accelerators, topical antibiotics, preservatives). Patches are applied to the back for 48 hours and read at 48, 72, and 96 hours.

### **Contact Dermatitis**

An inflammatory skin reaction caused by contact with an external substance. It may be allergic, involving delayed immune sensitization, or irritant, caused by direct chemical or physical injury.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dermatitis, Contact

### **Contact Precautions**

Infection control measures used for patients colonised or infected with multidrug-resistant organisms. Precautions include gown and glove use, patient placement in single rooms, and dedicated equipment. Contact precautions are used for MRSA, VRE, CRE, and other resistant organisms.

### **Contact Tracing**

Identifying and monitoring persons exposed to infectious disease. Critical for outbreak control. Examples: COVID-19, Ebola, TB.

### **Contagious Disease**

An infectious disease that can be transmitted directly or indirectly from one person, animal, or source to another.

### **Contamination**

Accidental presence of microorganisms in a specimen, on a surface, or in a normally sterile material without true infection of the host. Contamination can produce misleading culture results and must be distinguished from colonization and invasive disease.

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### Continuing Medical Education

Postgraduate education that maintains and updates a clinician's knowledge, skills, and professional competence.

### Continuity Of Care

Consistent and coordinated care over time and across clinicians or settings, integrating the patient's history, current needs, treatment plan, and preferences. It supports safety, adherence, prevention, and chronic-disease outcomes.

### Continuous Electronic Fetal Monitoring

The continuous recording of fetal heart rate (FHR) and uterine contractions using external transducers (Doppler ultrasound and tocodynamometer) or internal devices (fetal scalp electrode and intrauterine pressure catheter). Used intrapartum to detect fetal hypoxia.

### Continuous Glucose Monitoring

Technology measuring interstitial glucose levels continuously providing real-time glucose data, trends, and alerts. Sensors are inserted subcutaneously typically in the abdomen or arm and measure glucose every five minutes. Devices include Dexcom, FreeStyle Libre, and Medtronic Guardian systems.

### Continuous Kidney Replacement Therapy

A prolonged extracorporeal blood-purification therapy, usually delivered continuously in an intensive-care setting. It provides gradual fluid and solute removal and is useful for hemodynamically unstable patients with severe AKI.

### Continuous Murmurs

Murmurs that persist throughout systole and diastole without interruption, produced by blood flowing continuously through an abnormal connection. The most common cause is patent ductus arteriosus (PDA), where blood flows from the aorta to pulmonary artery throughout the cardiac cycle.

### Continuous Positive Airway Pressure

Noninvasive respiratory support that delivers a constant positive pressure throughout the breathing

cycle to keep the upper airway or alveoli open.

### Contraception

Methods to prevent pregnancy.

### Contraception And Birth Control

Contraception encompasses methods used to prevent pregnancy, including hormonal options like oral contraceptives, patches, rings, injections, and implants, as well as non-hormonal methods like copper IUDs, barrier methods, diaphragms, and permanent sterilization.

### Contraception For Adolescents

Methods to prevent unintended pregnancy. Options: combined oral contraceptives, progestin-only pills, depot medroxyprogesterone acetate, contraceptive implant (Nexplanon), intrauterine devices (IUDs), condoms, and abstinence.

### Contracted Pelvis

A pelvis whose size or shape is reduced or abnormal enough to interfere with passage of the fetus during labor.

### Contraction Stress Test

An antepartum test that evaluates the fetal heart rate response to uterine contractions. Contractions are induced with oxytocin or nipple stimulation (until 3 contractions in 10 minutes). Negative (normal): no late or significant variable decelerations. Positive (abnormal): late decelerations with  $\geq 50\%$  of contractions.

### Contractions

Rhythmic uterine muscular contractions of labor that produce cervical dilation and effacement, driving descent of the fetus. Characterized by frequency, duration, and intensity; progress is monitored by partogram and tocography (CTG). Braxton Hicks contractions: irregular, non-progressive, painless prelabor contractions.

### Contracture

Permanent or semi-permanent limitation of pas-

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sive joint range of motion caused by shortening or structural change in muscle, tendon, capsule, fascia, skin, or other periarticular tissue. Prevention and treatment depend on cause and stage.

### **Contracture Prevention**

Measures such as positioning, stretching, exercise, splinting, orthoses, and serial casting that help preserve joint movement in people at risk of fixed shortening.

### **Contraindication**

A clinical condition or finding involving contraindication. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Contraindications

### **Contralateral**

Located on the opposite side of the body.

### **Contrast Radiology (GI)**

Imaging of the gastrointestinal tract using contrast material, such as barium, to outline the esophagus, stomach, intestine, or colon on radiographs or fluoroscopy.

### **Contrast Agent**

Substance enhancing image visibility. X-ray/CT: iodine-based (positive contrast). MRI: gadolinium-based (shortens T1, bright on T1). Ultrasound: microbubble agents. Barium sulfate for GI studies.

### **Contrast Echocardiography**

Use of microbubble contrast agents to enhance endocardial border definition and assess myocardial perfusion. Indicated for suboptimal non-contrast echo images and assessment of myocardial viability. Microbubbles remain entirely within the intravascular space, making them ideal for perfusion assessment.

### **Contrast Reaction**

Adverse reaction to contrast agent. Mild: nausea, urticaria. Severe: anaphylaxis, bronchospasm. Pre-medication for prior reactions.

### **Contrast-Associated Acute Kidney Injury**

Acute worsening of kidney function occurring after administration of contrast, whether or not contrast is causal. Risk assessment includes baseline kidney function, hemodynamic status, diabetes, nephrotoxins, urgency, and the need to avoid unnecessary contrast exposure.

### **Contrast-Enhanced Ultrasound**

Ultrasound using microbubble contrast agents. Improves lesion characterization, perfusion assessment.

### **Contrast-Induced Nephropathy**

Acute kidney injury after iodinated contrast administration. Risk factors: pre-existing renal impairment, diabetes, dehydration. Prevention: hydration, lowest contrast volume, N-acetylcysteine controversial.

### **Contrecoup**

An injury occurring on the side of an organ opposite the site of impact, especially a brain injury produced when the brain moves within the skull after trauma.

### **Control Group**

The comparison group in a study, which may receive usual care, a placebo, or no intervention according to the study design.

### **Controlled Cord Traction**

A technique for active management of third-stage labor: gentle, steady traction on the umbilical cord with one hand while the other hand applies suprapubic counter-pressure (to prevent uterine inversion). Performed after signs of placental separation. The Brandt-Andrews maneuver and the Finocchietti technique are CCT methods.

### **Controlled Substance**

A drug or chemical whose manufacture, possession, and use are regulated by government authorities due to its potential for abuse, dependence, or harm.

### **Contusion**

A closed soft-tissue injury caused by blunt force,

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producing bleeding into tissues without an open wound. It commonly causes pain, swelling, and ecchymosis; severe contusions may involve muscle necrosis, compartment syndrome, internal bleeding, or associated bone and organ injury.

### **Conus Medullaris Syndrome**

A clinical condition resulting from damage to the conus medullaris, the tapered, terminal end of the spinal cord located at approximately the L1-L2 vertebral level.

### **Convergence Insufficiency**

Inability to maintain binocular convergence on near objects, causing eyestrain, headaches, blurred near vision, and transient diplopia during reading. Common in children and young adults; treated with convergence exercises and base-in prism, with surgery rarely needed.

### **Coombs Test**

A laboratory test that detects antibodies or complement attached to red blood cells, or antibodies in serum that can react with red cells. It is used in evaluating immune hemolysis and blood compatibility.

### **Cooper's Ligament**

Fibrous connective-tissue septa extending from the deep surface of the breast toward the skin and pectoral fascia. Tumor invasion or fibrosis may cause skin retraction.

### **Coordination**

Smooth, efficient movement. Tests: finger-to-nose, heel-to-shin, rapid alternating movements.

### **COPD**

Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease is a progressive, largely irreversible airflow limitation caused by chronic bronchitis, emphysema, or both, most commonly due to cigarette smoking. It presents with chronic cough, sputum production, and exertional dyspnea. Spirometry shows a reduced FEV1/FVC ratio.

### **COPD Exacerbation**

Acute worsening of respiratory symptoms beyond normal day-to-day variation in a patient with COPD that leads to additional therapy. Common triggers include viral or bacterial infection, air pollution, and cardiopulmonary comorbidity.

### **COPD Rehabilitation**

Comprehensive intervention for COPD patients including exercise training, education, behavior change. Components: aerobic exercise, strength training, breathing techniques, nutrition, psychosocial support. Improves exercise capacity, quality of life, reduces hospitalizations.

### **Copper**

An essential trace element required for iron transport, connective-tissue cross-linking, energy metabolism, neurotransmitter synthesis, and antioxidant enzymes. Deficiency can cause anemia, neutropenia, impaired neurologic function, and bone abnormalities; excess is toxic and accumulates in Wilson disease.

### **Copy Number Variation**

Deletions or duplications of DNA segments >1 kb. Contribute to genetic diversity and disease. Examples: 22q11.2 deletion, Williams syndrome (7q11.23 deletion).

### **Cor Pulmonale**

Right ventricular hypertrophy and dilation from pulmonary hypertension due to lung disease. Features include peripheral edema, JVD, and hepatomegaly.

### **Cor Triatriatum**

A rare congenital heart defect where the left atrium is divided into two chambers by a fibromuscular membrane, separating the pulmonary venous chamber (posterior) from the true left atrium (anterior) containing the left atrial appendage and mitral valve. The membrane obstructs pulmonary venous return, mimicking mitral stenosis.

### **Coracoid Process**

Hook-like scapular projection extending anteriorly



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and laterally. Attachment for 3 muscles (pectoralis minor, coracobrachialis, short head of biceps) and 3 ligaments. Important surgical landmark. Fractures uncommon but may occur with direct trauma or shoulder dislocations.

### **Cord Presentation**

The presence of the umbilical cord between the presenting fetal part and the cervix, with intact membranes. Risk factors: malpresentation, unstable lie, low-lying placenta, and long cord. If the membranes rupture, the cord may prolapse (umbilical cord prolapse).

### **Cordocentesis**

A prenatal diagnostic procedure in which fetal blood is sampled from the umbilical cord, usually under ultrasound guidance.

### **Cordotomy**

Surgical division of selected nerve fibers, especially a spinal cord tract, to interrupt transmission of severe chronic pain.

### **Core Biopsy**

Removal of a cylindrical sample of tissue with a hollow cutting needle for microscopic examination, commonly used for breast, liver, prostate, and other lesions.

### **Core Needle Biopsy**

Biopsy using core needle. CT, ultrasound, or MRI guidance.

### **Cori Cycle**

Lactate produced by muscles transported to liver, converted to glucose via gluconeogenesis, returned to muscles.

### **Cornea**

Transparent, avascular, dome-shaped anterior eye surface providing approximately two-thirds of total refractive power. Five layers: epithelium (stratified squamous, rapidly regenerating), Bowman's membrane, stroma (thickest, regular collagen), De-

scemet's membrane, endothelium (single cell layer maintaining transparency).

### **Corneal Abrasion**

Loss of corneal epithelium caused by mechanical trauma — contact with fingernail, makeup brush, foreign body, contact lens overwear, dry eye, sports injury, paper edge, or surgical instrumentation. Most common eye injury presenting to emergency departments.

### **Corneal Cross-Linking**

Corneal collagen cross-linking is a minimally invasive therapeutic procedure that strengthens the corneal stroma by creating additional chemical bonds between collagen fibrils, thereby stiffening the cornea and halting or slowing the progression of corneal ectatic disorders, particularly keratoconus and post-refractive surgery ectasia.

### **Corneal Edema**

Excess fluid within the corneal stroma or epithelium causing corneal thickening, reduced transparency, glare, and blurred vision. Causes include endothelial dysfunction, acute glaucoma, inflammation, trauma, and postoperative injury.

### **Corneal Implant**

An implanted device or tissue substitute placed in or on the cornea to restore vision, replace diseased tissue, or alter corneal shape.

### **Corneal Ulcer**

A corneal ulcer is a defect in the corneal epithelium with associated stromal inflammation and necrosis, typically caused by infectious or non-infectious mechanisms, and it is a sight-threatening condition that requires prompt diagnosis and treatment.

### **Corneitis**

Inflammation of the cornea, often producing pain, photophobia, tearing, and impaired vision. It may be infectious, immune-mediated, traumatic, or related to exposure.



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### **Cornelia De Lange Syndrome**

A genetic disorder caused by mutations in genes of the cohesin complex (NIPBL 60%, SMC1A, SMC3, RAD21, HDAC8).

### **Corns And Calluses**

Corns (heloma) are focal areas of hyperkeratosis caused by pressure and friction, typically on toes. Hard corns (heloma durum) occur on dorsal toes; soft corns (heloma molle) occur between toes. Calluses (tyloma) are diffuse hyperkeratosis on weight-bearing surfaces.

### **Coronal Caries**

Caries on clinical crown. Smooth surface or pits/fissures.

### **Coronal Plane**

A vertical plane that divides the body or an organ into front (anterior) and back (posterior) portions.

### **Coronary Angiography**

Invasive imaging of the coronary arteries using catheter-delivered contrast and X-ray fluoroscopy. It shows coronary anatomy and stenosis and can support treatment planning; noninvasive tests may be appropriate in other clinical settings.

### **Coronary Arteries**

The right and left arteries arising from the aortic sinuses that supply the myocardium. Their branches include the right coronary, anterior interventricular, and circumflex arteries.

### **Coronary Artery**

One of the blood vessels branching from the aorta that supplies oxygen-rich blood directly to the heart muscle.

### **Coronary Artery Aneurysm**

A localized dilatation of a coronary artery exceeding the normal vessel diameter by approximately 1.5 times. It may be caused by atherosclerosis, Kawasaki disease, connective-tissue disorders, infection, trauma, or an iatrogenic procedure, and can

lead to thrombosis, distal embolization, myocardial ischemia, or rupture.

### **Coronary Artery Bypass**

A surgical procedure that creates a new route for blood flow around a narrowed or blocked coronary artery using a vascular graft.

### **Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting**

A surgical revascularization procedure for severe coronary artery disease (CAD). Grafts, most commonly the left internal mammary artery (LIMA) and saphenous vein grafts (SVG), are used to bypass stenotic coronary arterial segments. Indicated for multi-vessel CAD, left main coronary artery stenosis, or severe CAD in diabetic patients.

### **Coronary Artery Disease**

Narrowing or occlusion of coronary arteries, usually due to atherosclerosis, reducing blood flow to the myocardium. Risk factors include hypertension, diabetes, hyperlipidemia, smoking, family history, and obesity. CAD can present as stable angina, acute coronary syndromes (unstable angina, NSTEMI, STEMI), or sudden cardiac death.

### **Coronary Artery Spasm**

Transient intense constriction of an epicardial coronary artery that reduces myocardial blood flow. It may cause rest angina and transient ST-segment elevation and can be triggered by smoking, stimulants, or endothelial dysfunction; calcium-channel blockers and nitrates are commonly used for prevention and relief.

### **Coronary Calcium Score**

A CT-based measurement of coronary artery calcification, quantified as the Agatston score. A score of 0 indicates very low risk of cardiovascular events; >400 indicates high burden and significant atherosclerosis. It is used for cardiovascular risk stratification in asymptomatic individuals and may guide statin therapy decisions.

### **Coronary Calcium Scoring**

Non-contrast CT measuring calcified plaque in coro-

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nary arteries. Agatston score predicts cardiovascular risk.

### Coronary Circulation

The vascular system supplying blood to the myocardium. The left coronary artery (LCA) divides into the left anterior descending (LAD) and circumflex (LCx) arteries. The right coronary artery (RCA) supplies the right ventricle, SA node (in 60% of people), and inferior left ventricular wall.

### Coronary Dominance

Determined by which artery gives rise to the posterior descending artery (PDA). Right coronary dominance (85% of people): RCA gives rise to PDA. Left coronary dominance (8%): LCx gives rise to PDA. Codominance (7%): both RCA and LCx contribute.

### Coronary Heart Disease

Disease caused by reduced blood flow through the coronary arteries, usually due to atherosclerotic plaque. It may cause angina, myocardial infarction, heart failure, or sudden cardiac death. Also called coronary artery disease.

#### Synonyms:

coronary artery disease.

### Coronary Insufficiency

Inadequate blood flow through the coronary circulation to meet myocardial oxygen demand, usually because of coronary artery disease.

### Coronary Microvascular Dysfunction

Impairment of the small coronary arteries and arterioles causing impaired coronary flow reserve despite normal epicardial coronary arteries. Common in women, patients with diabetes, and hypertension. Causes chest pain (angina equivalent) and may contribute to heart failure with preserved ejection fraction.

### Coronary Occlusion

Obstruction of a coronary artery, commonly by atherosclerotic plaque and thrombus, that can cause myocardial ischemia or infarction.

### Coronary Sinus

A large vein on the back of the heart that collects de-oxygenated blood from the heart muscle and drains it into the right atrium.

### Coronary Stent

Mesh tube keeping coronary artery open after angioplasty. Types: bare-metal (higher restenosis), drug-eluting (releases antiproliferative drug, lower restenosis but prolonged DAPT). Complications: stent thrombosis, restenosis, bleeding (from DAPT).

### Coronary Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot in a coronary artery, potentially obstructing blood flow and causing myocardial infarction.

### Coronavirus Disease 2019

A respiratory and systemic infectious disease caused by SARS-CoV-2. Illness ranges from asymptomatic infection to pneumonia, respiratory failure, and multisystem complications.

### Corpse

The dead body of a human being; the subject of medicolegal examination. Forensic assessment of a corpse includes identification, determination of death and time of death (rigor mortis, livor mortis, algor mortis, vitreous potassium, gastric emptying), external and internal examination, and collection of evidence.

### Corpus Callosum

Brain's largest white matter tract with approximately 200 million axons connecting left and right hemispheres. Four parts: rostrum, genu, body, splenium. Facilitates interhemispheric communication for sensory, motor, and cognitive integration.

### Corrected Age

The age of a preterm infant calculated by subtracting the number of weeks born before 40 weeks of gestation from chronological age. Corrected age helps interpret growth and developmental milestones during early childhood, commonly until about 2 years of age.

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### Corrigan Pulse

A forceful, rapidly rising and collapsing arterial pulse, classically associated with aortic regurgitation.

### Corrosive

Substance causing tissue destruction by chemical action. Acids: coagulation necrosis, eschar. Alkalis: liquefaction necrosis, deep penetration. Ingestion: avoid emesis, endoscopy, surgical consultation.

### Corti's Ganglion

The spiral ganglion of the cochlea, containing the cell bodies of sensory neurons that transmit auditory information from the organ of Corti.

### Cortical Cataract

A type of age-related lens opacity that begins in the peripheral lens cortex as wedge-shaped or spoke-like opacities that extend centripetally toward the visual axis, caused by disruption of the normally orderly arrangement of lens fibers and the accumulation of fluid between them.

### Corticobasal Degeneration

A rare, progressive neurodegenerative disorder characterized by asymmetric cortical and basal ganglia dysfunction. Presents with asymmetric parkinsonism (rigidity, bradykinesia), apraxia (loss of learned motor skills), alien limb phenomenon (involuntary, purposeless movements), cortical sensory loss, myoclonus, and dystonia.

### Corticosteroids

Synthetic glucocorticoids with potent anti-inflammatory and immunosuppressive effects. Examples include prednisone, prednisolone, methylprednisolone, dexamethasone, and hydrocortisone. They suppress inflammatory gene expression and inhibit immune cell function.

### Corticosteroids Mechanism

Corticosteroids exert their anti-inflammatory and immunosuppressive effects primarily by binding to intracellular glucocorticoid receptors, which then translocate to the nucleus and modulate gene tran-

scription.

### Cortisol

The primary glucocorticoid produced by the adrenal cortex (zona fasciculata) under ACTH control; essential for stress response, metabolism, and homeostasis. Functions: gluconeogenesis, glycogenolysis, protein catabolism, lipolysis, anti-inflammatory/immunosuppressive effects, and maintenance of vascular tone.

### Coryza

Acute inflammation of the nasal mucous membranes with nasal discharge and obstruction, commonly occurring in the common cold or other upper-respiratory infection.

### Cosmetic Dermatology

Cosmetic dermatology encompasses aesthetic procedures. Botulinum toxin injections (Botox, Dysport, Xeomin) relax facial muscles reducing wrinkles. Dermal fillers (hyaluronic acid, calcium hydroxylapatite, poly-L-lactic acid, polymethylmethacrylate) restore volume.

### Cost-Effectiveness

Comparison of costs and outcomes of interventions. Used for resource allocation.

### Costochondritis

Costochondritis is inflammation or irritation where ribs join the breastbone, causing localized chest pain often worse with movement or pressing the area.

#### Synonyms:

Chest Wall Pain Costosternal Chondrodynia Costosternal Syndrome

### Cot Death

Sudden infant death syndrome, the sudden unexplained death of an apparently healthy infant, usually during sleep, that remains unexplained after investigation.

### Cough

Cough is a protective reflex that clears the airways;

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its duration, triggers, sputum, associated symptoms, and examination findings help distinguish infectious, inflammatory, cardiac, and other causes. foreign material from the tracheobronchial tree.

### **Cough Augmentation**

Techniques to improve cough effectiveness in patients with neuromuscular disease or chest wall weakness. Methods include manually assisted cough (abdominal thrust timed with cough), mechanical insufflation-exsufflation (CoughAssist device), and breath stacking with a resuscitation bag.

### **Count Rate**

Number of detected events per second. Dead time losses at high count rates.

### **Countercurrent Multiplication**

The renal medullary process in which opposing tubular fluid flow and selective permeability along the loop of Henle generate a corticomedullary osmotic gradient. This gradient permits collecting-duct water reabsorption when antidiuretic hormone is present.

### **Countertransference**

The therapist's emotional reactions to the patient, which may be influenced by the therapist's own unresolved conflicts or may be a response to the patient's transference. Awareness of countertransference is essential for effective therapy and can provide valuable clinical information about the patient's interpersonal style.

### **Coup-Contrecoup Injury**

Brain injury from acceleration-deceleration trauma. Coup: injury at site of impact. Contrecoup: injury on opposite side. Common in falls, motor vehicle accidents.

### **Courvoisier Sign**

Clinical finding of a palpable non-tender gallbladder in obstructive jaundice suggesting malignant biliary obstruction. In gallstone disease, the gallbladder is typically fibrotic and not palpable, whereas in malignant obstruction it is distended because the

wall is initially normal and compliant.

### **Covered Stent (Vascular)**

A vascular stent lined with a graft material that supports the vessel and excludes a leak or aneurysm from the bloodstream.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **COVID Toe**

A chilblain-like skin lesion reported in association with COVID-19, usually affecting the toes or fingers and appearing red, purple, or swollen.

### **COVID-19 In Pregnancy**

Pregnant women with COVID-19 are at increased risk of severe illness (ICU admission, mechanical ventilation, death) compared to non-pregnant women. Risks to the fetus: preterm birth, cesarean delivery, and possibly stillbirth. Vertical transmission is rare but possible.

### **COVID-19 Test**

A test that detects SARS-CoV-2 infection. Nucleic acid amplification tests, including RT-PCR, detect viral genetic material, while rapid antigen tests detect viral proteins. Test performance depends on timing, specimen quality, and the amount of virus present.

### **Cowden Syndrome**

Autosomal dominant PTEN hamartoma tumor syndrome (PHTS), caused by loss-of-function mutations in PTEN (10q23) — a negative regulator of the PI3K/AKT/mTOR pathway. Multiple hamartomas and increased risk of benign and malignant tumors.

### **Cowper's Gland**

One of a pair of small male accessory sex glands below the prostate. Its secretion contributes mucus and fluid to the urethra before ejaculation.

### **Cowpox**

A zoonotic viral infection caused by cowpox virus or

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related orthopoxviruses, producing localized pustular or ulcerative skin lesions and sometimes systemic illness.

### **COX Inhibitor**

A class of drugs that inhibit cyclooxygenase enzymes (COX-1 and COX-2), which catalyze the conversion of arachidonic acid to prostaglandins and thromboxanes. COX-1 is constitutively expressed in most tissues, producing prostaglandins that protect the gastric mucosa, maintain renal blood flow, and support platelet aggregation.

### **Coxa Vara**

A deformity in which the angle between the femoral neck and shaft is abnormally reduced, potentially causing a limp, shortened limb, or altered hip mechanics.

### **Coxalgia**

Pain in the hip or hip joint.

### **Coxiella Burnetii**

An obligate intracellular bacterium that causes Q fever, a zoonotic infection transmitted from animals to humans. The organism is transmitted through inhalation of contaminated aerosols or ingestion of contaminated dairy products. Acute Q fever presents with fever, headache, and pneumonia. Chronic Q fever can cause endocarditis.

### **Coxsackie Virus Type A16**

A member of the Enterovirus genus and the most common cause of hand, foot, and mouth disease, a mild, self-limited viral illness affecting children. It presents with fever, oral vesicles and ulcers, and a maculopapular or vesicular rash on the hands and feet. Complications are rare but may include aseptic meningitis.

### **Coxsackievirus**

A group of enteroviruses that cause a range of human diseases. Group A viruses commonly cause hand-foot-and-mouth disease and herpangina, whereas group B viruses are associated with myocarditis, pericarditis, pleurodynia, and aseptic meningitis.

### **CPAP**

Continuous positive airway pressure delivered through a mask to splint open the upper airway during sleep. It is commonly used for obstructive sleep apnea and can reduce apneas and related symptoms when used consistently.

### **CPAP Machine**

Continuous positive airway pressure for sleep apnea.

### **Cracked Tooth Syndrome**

Incomplete fracture of tooth causing pain on biting. Diagnosis difficult. Treatment: crown, root canal if pulpal involvement.

### **Crackles (Rales)**

Discontinuous, non-musical adventitious lung sounds produced by the sudden explosive opening of collapsed small airways and alveoli during inspiration or the bubbling of air through fluid in the bronchioles.

#### **Synonyms:**

Rales

### **Cradle Cap**

A common form of seborrheic dermatitis in infants, causing greasy or flaky scales on the scalp with mild redness. It is usually harmless and improves with gentle scalp care; persistent inflammation or signs of infection require assessment.

### **Cranial Arteritis**

Giant-cell arteritis, an inflammatory disease of medium and large arteries, especially branches of the external carotid artery, that can cause headache, visual loss, and systemic symptoms.

### **Cranial Cavity**

The hollow space inside the skull that contains and protects the brain.

### **Cranial Implant**

An artificial device placed in or on the skull or cranial cavity for reconstruction, protection, drainage, stimulation, or treatment.



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## Cranial Nerve

Twelve paired nerves (CN I-XII) emerging directly from the brain/brainstem, primarily serving head and neck.

## Cranial Nerve Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of one or more cranial nerves, causing deficits such as impaired eye movement, facial weakness, hearing loss, swallowing difficulty, or tongue weakness. The cause may be vascular, traumatic, compressive, inflammatory, infectious, or metabolic.

## Craniectomy

Surgical removal of part of the skull without immediate replacement, performed to relieve intracranial pressure or provide access to the brain.

## Craniocerebral Injury

An injury involving the scalp, skull, brain, or more than one of these structures.

## Craniofacial Abnormalities

Abnormalities of the skull, face, or related tissues that may be present at birth or develop later. Causes include genetic conditions, disrupted development, trauma, infection, and tumors.

## Craniofacial Dysostosis

A congenital disorder involving premature fusion of cranial sutures and characteristic abnormalities of the face and skull, such as those seen in Crouzon syndrome.

## Craniopharyngioma

A clinical condition or finding involving craniopharyngioma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Cranioplasty

Surgical repair or reconstruction of a skull defect using bone, an implant, or another suitable material.

## Craniosynostosis

Craniosynostosis is premature fusion of one or more skull sutures, altering head shape and sometimes increasing pressure on the developing brain.

### Synonyms:

Congenital Plagiocephaly

## Craniotomy

Surgical opening of the skull (bone flap) for access to intracranial contents. Indications: brain tumor resection (glioblastoma, meningioma, mets), hematoma evacuation (SDH, EDH, ICH), aneurysm clipping, AVM resection, and epilepsy surgery (lobectomy).

## Crazy Paving Pattern

A HRCT finding characterized by ground-glass opacification with superimposed interlobular septal thickening and intralobular lines. It is seen in pulmonary alveolar proteinosis, lipoid pneumonia, ARDS, pulmonary hemorrhage, and Pneumocystis pneumonia. Despite its name, it is not specific to any single diagnosis.

## CRE

Carbapenem-resistant Enterobacteriaceae, resistant to carbapenem antibiotics through production of carbapenemases including KPC, NDM, and OXA-48-like enzymes. CRE are a major public health threat due to limited treatment options. Infections are associated with high mortality rates.

## Cream

A semisolid emulsion (oil in water or water in oil) for topical application, containing a drug in an emulsion base. Creams are lighter, less greasy, and easier to spread than ointments, and are preferred for moist or oozing skin lesions. They penetrate less deeply than ointments and are cosmetically acceptable.

## Creatine Kinase

An enzyme found in muscle, brain, and heart. CK-MB: cardiac isoenzyme (used historically for MI diagnosis, largely replaced by troponin). CK-MM: skeletal muscle (elevated in rhabdomyolysis, trauma, statins, myopathy). Total CK: elevated in mus-



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cle injury, myocardial infarction, seizures, hypothyroidism, and statin myopathy.

### **Creatinine**

A breakdown product of muscle creatine phosphate produced at a constant rate, filtered by the glomerulus and minimally reabsorbed; serum creatinine is the most used marker of kidney function.

### **CREST Syndrome**

A limited cutaneous form of systemic sclerosis characterized by calcinosis, Raynaud phenomenon, esophageal dysmotility, sclerodactyly, and telangiectasia. It may involve pulmonary vascular disease and other systemic complications.

### **Creutzfeld-Jakob Disease**

A rapidly progressive neurodegenerative disease caused by abnormal prion proteins, leading to cognitive decline, ataxia, myoclonus, and death.

### **Creutzfeldt Jakob Disease**

Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease (CJD) is a rare, fatal, transmissible spongiform encephalopathy caused by the accumulation of misfolded prion protein (PrP<sup>Sc</sup>) in the brain, leading to rapid, progressive dementia and myoclonus.

### **Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease**

A rapidly progressive fatal neurodegenerative disease caused by abnormal prion protein, characterized by dementia, myoclonus, ataxia, and other neurologic signs.

#### **Synonyms:**

CJD Mad Cow Disease Variant CJD VCJD

### **Cri Du Chat Syndrome**

A congenital genetic disorder caused by deletion of part of the short arm of chromosome 5, characterized in infancy by a high-pitched cry, developmental delay, and characteristic facial features.

### **Cri-Du-Chat Syndrome**

A genetic disorder caused by a deletion of the short arm of chromosome 5 (5p-), with the size of the

deletion correlating with severity. Incidence 1 in 15,000-50,000.

### **Cricoid Cartilage**

The cricoid cartilage is a complete, ring-shaped cartilage located at the base of the larynx, directly above the trachea and below the thyroid cartilage, and it is the only complete cartilaginous ring in the airway, providing structural support and maintaining airway patency.

### **Cricoid Pressure**

Cricoid pressure (Sellick maneuver) applies posterior displacement of the cricoid cartilage against the cervical vertebrae, occluding the esophagus and reducing aspiration risk during rapid sequence intubation.

### **Cricothyrotomy**

An emergency airway procedure that creates an opening through the cricothyroid membrane to provide oxygenation and ventilation when a patient cannot be intubated and cannot be oxygenated by less invasive methods.

### **Criminal Abortion**

Abortion performed illegally, outside permitted legal indications and procedures (e.g., unsafe methods, unqualified practitioners, or non-medical settings), carrying high maternal risk.

### **CRISPR-Cas9**

Genome editing tool derived from bacterial immune system. Cas9 enzyme guided by RNA to specific DNA sequence, creating double-strand break. Repaired by non-homologous end joining (NHEJ) or homology-directed repair (HDR). Applications: research, therapy.

### **Critical Care**

Specialized care for people with life-threatening illness or injury who need close monitoring and support for failing organs.

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## Critical Findings

Findings requiring immediate communication. Examples: pneumothorax, brain herniation, aortic dissection.

## Critical Limb Ischemia

Severe chronic reduction in limb blood flow causing ischemic rest pain, nonhealing wounds, or gangrene. It requires urgent vascular assessment.

## Critical Results

Test results indicating a potentially life-threatening condition that require prompt communication and clinical action.

## Critical Value

A laboratory result indicating a potentially life-threatening condition that requires prompt communication to a responsible clinician or care team. The threshold is test- and laboratory-specific and should be defined by institutional policy.

## Crohn Disease

Chronic transmural inflammatory condition that can affect any segment of the gastrointestinal tract from the oral cavity to the perianal region, though the terminal ileum and ileocolonic region are most commonly involved.

## Crohn Disease Cobblestoning

Endoscopic appearance of the colonic or small bowel mucosa in Crohn disease characterized by a bumpy, irregular surface resembling cobblestones. This distinctive appearance results from intersecting lines of deep linear and serpiginous ulceration that surround areas of relatively preserved or edematous but intact mucosa.

## Cross-Sectional Study

Measures exposure and outcome at same time. Prevalence study. Cannot establish temporality.

## Cross-Tolerance

Tolerance to one substance that extends to another substance with a similar mechanism of action. For

example, tolerance to one benzodiazepine extends to all benzodiazepines, and tolerance to alcohol extends partially to benzodiazepines due to shared GABA-A receptor mechanisms.

## Croup

A clinical condition or finding involving croup. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Synonyms:

Laryngotracheobronchitis (Croup)

## Crouzon Syndrome

An autosomal dominant craniosynostosis syndrome caused by mutations in the FGFR2 or FGFR3 genes, leading to premature fusion of multiple cranial sutures. Features: brachycephaly (short, broad head from bilateral coronal synostosis), proptosis (shallow orbits), hypertelorism, midface hypoplasia, beaked nose, and Class III malocclusion.

## Crown (Dental)

Cap covering damaged tooth. Materials: metal, porcelain-fused-to-metal, all-ceramic, zirconia. Indications: large caries, fractured tooth, root canal treated tooth.

### Synonyms:

Dental

## Crown Lengthening

Surgical procedure exposing more tooth structure. Involves gingivectomy and bone removal. For restorative or aesthetic purposes.

## Crown-Rump Length

The measurement from the top of the fetal head (crown) to the bottom of the buttocks (rump), the most accurate method for establishing gestational age in the first trimester. Measured at 7-13 weeks. Accuracy:  $\pm 3$ -5 days. The EDD is set using CRL if the difference from LMP dating exceeds 7 days. CRL growth: approximately 1 mm per day.

## Crowning

The stage of the second stage of labor when the

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fetal head (widest diameter) distends the perineum and becomes visible at the introitus and is no longer receding between contractions.

### **CRP**

C-reactive protein. Acute phase reactant. Marker of inflammation.

### **Crush Syndrome**

Systemic manifestations of prolonged muscle crush injury (rhabdomyolysis) following trauma — typically from collapsed buildings, landslides, entrapment under debris, or excessive compression of limbs. Bywaters syndrome.

### **Crushing Injury**

Damage caused when a body part is compressed between heavy objects. It can produce fractures, nerve and blood-vessel injury, tissue death, and rhabdomyolysis. Severe limb compression or sudden release after prolonged entrapment requires emergency treatment.

### **Crusted Scabies**

A severe, highly contagious form of scabies (Norwegian scabies) characterised by thick, hyperkeratotic crusts teeming with enormous numbers of *Sarcoptes scabiei* mites, typically occurring in immunocompromised, elderly, or neurologically impaired individuals.

### **Crutches**

Walking aids. Types: axillary, forearm (Loftstrand). Axillary: under arm. Forearm: through loop.

### **Cryoablation**

A procedure that freezes and destroys selected tissue, often using imaging to guide the treatment.

### **Cryobiopsy**

A bronchoscopic technique using rapid freezing to obtain larger lung tissue samples than conventional transbronchial biopsy. It provides better histopathological specimens for diagnosing interstitial lung diseases. It requires general anesthesia and bron-

choscopic expertise. It is less invasive than surgical lung biopsy.

### **Cryoglobulinemic Vasculitis**

Systemic vasculitis caused by cryoglobulin-containing immune complexes that deposit in small and medium vessels, classically presenting with purpura, arthralgia, and glomerulonephritis. Most cases are associated with hepatitis C virus infection.

### **Cryoglobulins**

A clinical condition or finding involving cryoglobulins. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cryopexy**

A procedure that uses controlled freezing to destroy or seal abnormal tissue, especially retinal breaks or small retinal detachments.

### **Cryoprecipitate**

A plasma fraction rich in fibrinogen, factor VIII, von Willebrand factor, and factor XIII, used selectively to treat certain bleeding disorders.

### **Cryopreservation**

Preservation of cells, tissues, or embryos by cooling them to very low temperatures, usually with protective substances that limit ice-related injury.

### **Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndromes**

Autosomal dominant autoinflammatory disorders (NLRP3 mutations, gain-of-function) causing constitutive inflammasome activation and IL-1 $\beta$  overproduction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cryopyrin-Associated Autoinflammatory Syndromes

### **Cryosurgery**

Surgery that destroys abnormal tissue by controlled freezing, used in selected skin lesions, tumors, and other conditions.

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## Cryotherapy

The therapeutic application of extreme cold (typically using liquid nitrogen at  $-196^{\circ}\text{C}$ ) to destroy abnormal or diseased tissue.

## Cryptitis

Inflammation of a crypt or small anatomical recess, especially inflammation of the anal glands and crypts.

## Cryptococcal Meningitis

Infection of the meninges by *Cryptococcus*, usually in people with impaired immunity, causing headache, fever, altered mental status, or other neurologic symptoms.

## Cryptococcosis

Cryptococcosis is fungal infection caused by *Cryptococcus*, often affecting the lungs or brain in people with immune suppression.

### Synonyms:

Infection *Cryptococcus* (Cryptococcosis)

## Cryptococcus Neoformans

An encapsulated yeast that can cause pulmonary or central nervous system infection, especially in people with impaired immunity.

## Cryptogenic Organizing Pneumonia

An inflammatory lung disease with granulation tissue within alveolar ducts. May be idiopathic or secondary to infection, drugs, or connective tissue disease. Responds well to corticosteroids.

## Cryptorchidism

Failure of one or both testes to descend into the scrotum, the most common congenital genitourinary anomaly in boys (3% at birth, 1% at 1 year). 70% of undescended testes are palpable (inguinal), 30% non-palpable (intra-abdominal, absent, or atrophic). Spontaneous descent by 6 months occurs in about one-third.

## Cryptosporidiosis

A diarrhoeal disease caused by the protozoan para-

site *Cryptosporidium parvum* (zoonotic) or *C. hominis* (anthroponotic), transmitted via contaminated water (chlorine-resistant oocysts), food, or direct contact. Presents with watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, and low-grade fever, lasting 1-2 weeks.

## Crystal Arthropathy

Joint disease caused by crystal deposition. Gout (monosodium urate) and pseudogout (calcium pyrophosphate). Diagnosis by joint aspiration and polarized microscopy.

## Crystalloids

Aqueous solutions of mineral salts that distribute between intravascular and interstitial compartments. Normal saline (0.9 percent NaCl) has 154 mEq/L each of sodium and chloride, pH 5.4, and is associated with hyperchloremic metabolic acidosis at large volumes.

## Crystalluria

The presence of crystals in urine, which may reflect precipitation of salts, medication effects, metabolic disease, or a tendency to form urinary stones.

## CSF Analysis

Laboratory examination of cerebrospinal fluid obtained by lumbar puncture. Tests may assess cells, protein, glucose, microorganisms, and other markers of infection, inflammation, bleeding, or malignancy.

## CSF Rhinorrhea

Cerebrospinal fluid rhinorrhea is the leakage of cerebrospinal fluid from the subarachnoid space through a defect in the skull base into the nasal cavity or paranasal sinuses, resulting in a clear, watery nasal discharge that may be mistaken for allergic rhinitis or sinusitis.

## CT Angiography

CT imaging with IV contrast timed to visualize arteries. Coronary CTA: assesses coronary artery stenosis and plaque, calcium scoring (Agatston). CTA chest: pulmonary embolism (PE protocol), aortic dissection. CTA head/neck: stroke evalua-

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tion, aneurysm, dissection, and vasculitis.

### **CT Chest**

Detailed lung and mediastinal imaging. High-resolution CT (HRCT) for interstitial lung disease. CT pulmonary angiography (CTPA) for pulmonary embolism. Lung cancer screening with low-dose CT.

### **CT Colonography**

CT imaging of the colon after bowel preparation and insufflation with air or carbon dioxide. Used for colorectal cancer screening in patients unable to undergo optical colonoscopy and for evaluating complete colonoscopy when the cecum was not reached. Detects polyps greater than six millimeters with high sensitivity.

### **CT Colonography (Virtual Colonoscopy)**

CT imaging of the colon after bowel preparation and air insufflation. Indications: colorectal cancer screening (alternative to colonoscopy), incomplete colonoscopy due to obstructing mass, and patients unable to undergo colonoscopy. Sensitivity >90% for polyps >10mm. Requires same bowel prep as colonoscopy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Virtual Colonoscopy

### **CT Contrast**

A substance administered during computed tomography to make selected tissues, vessels, or body spaces more visible.

### **CT Coronary Angiography**

CT imaging of coronary arteries after contrast. Detects stenosis, plaque. Alternative to invasive angiography in low-intermediate risk.

### **CT Dose-Length Product**

A CT dose metric calculated from the volume CT dose index and scan length. It estimates the total scanner output for an examination and is used for protocol optimization and dose monitoring, not as a direct patient-specific risk estimate.

### **CT Enterography**

CT imaging of the small bowel after administration of large volumes of neutral oral contrast distending the small bowel with IV contrast. Excellent for evaluating Crohn disease, small bowel tumors, and obscure gastrointestinal bleeding.

### **CT Perfusion**

A CT technique that estimates blood flow and related perfusion parameters in tissue, commonly to assess selected cases of acute stroke or tumors.

### **CT Pulmonary Angiography**

CT imaging performed after intravenous contrast to show the pulmonary arteries and evaluate suspected pulmonary embolism or other vascular abnormalities.

### **CT Scan**

Computed tomography, an imaging method that uses X-rays and computer processing to produce cross-sectional images of the body.

### **CT Scan (Computed Tomography)**

Cross-sectional imaging using X-rays and computer reconstruction. Non-contrast: evaluate hemorrhage, stones, and bone. IV contrast (iodinated): evaluate inflammation, infection, tumor, and vascular structures. Oral contrast: opacify bowel.

#### **Synonyms:**

Computed Tomography

### **Cubital Tunnel Syndrome**

Cubital tunnel syndrome: ulnar nerve compression at elbow (cubital tunnel: Osborne's ligament, FCU aponeurosis, medial epicondyle, olecranon). Clinical: paresthesias ulnar 1.5 digits, nocturnal, Tinel at elbow, Froment sign (IP flexion of thumb with key pinch), Wartenberg sign (abduction of small finger), thenar/hypothenar wasting late.

### **Cubitus Valgus**

An abnormal outward angulation of the forearm relative to the upper arm when the elbow is extended.

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### **Cubitus Varus**

An abnormal inward angulation of the forearm relative to the upper arm when the elbow is extended, often developing after a childhood elbow fracture.

### **Cuboid**

Cube-shaped lateral foot tarsal bone articulating with calcaneus proximally and 4th/5th metatarsals distally. Attachment for the long plantar ligament and peroneus longus tendon. Keystone of the lateral longitudinal arch. Cuboid syndrome (subluxation) is a common lateral foot pain cause in athletes from excessive pronation.

### **Culdocentesis**

Surgical puncture of the posterior vaginal fornix to sample or drain fluid from the rectouterine pouch.

### **Cullen's Sign**

Bluish or violaceous periumbilical ecchymosis caused by blood tracking through the fascial planes to the umbilicus. It is a sign of intra-abdominal or retroperitoneal haemorrhage, classically severe haemorrhagic pancreatitis, and is associated with serious underlying disease.

### **Cultural Psychiatry**

The study and clinical practice of how cultural factors influence mental health, illness expression, diagnosis, and treatment. Cultural concepts of distress, idioms of distress, and cultural syndromes must be considered. The DSM-5 includes a Cultural Formulation Interview.

### **Culture And Sensitivity**

Microbiological culture of a clinical specimen (blood, urine, sputum, wound swab, CSF) to identify pathogens and determine antimicrobial susceptibility. Culture media: blood agar (most bacteria), MacConkey (Gram-negative), chocolate agar (fastidious: *N. gonorrhoeae*, *H. influenzae*), and selective media.

### **Culture Media**

Nutrient preparations used to grow microorganisms in the laboratory, classified by composition and

purpose.

### **Culture Swab**

Swab for microbial culture. Types: bacterial, viral, fungal.

### **Cumulative Dose**

Total amount of substance received over time. Important for carcinogens, teratogens, cumulative toxins.

### **Cumulative Trauma Disorder**

A disorder caused by repeated forceful or awkward movements that progressively injure muscles, tendons, nerves, or other soft tissues.

### **Cup-To-Disc Ratio**

The cup-to-disc ratio is a clinical measurement used to assess the severity of glaucomatous optic nerve damage, comparing the diameter of the optic cup (the central depression within the optic nerve head where neural tissue is absent) to the diameter of the optic disc (the entire optic nerve head).

### **CURB-65 Score**

One point each for: Confusion, Urea > 7 mmol/L, RR > 30, BP < 90/60, age ≥ 65. 0–1: outpatient. 2: consider hospitalization. 3–5: severe.

### **Curettage**

Removal of tissue from a body cavity or surface with a curette, used for diagnosis, treatment, or removal of abnormal tissue.

### **Curettage Specimen**

Tissue obtained by scraping or scooping a surface or cavity, such as the endometrium or a bone lesion, for histologic examination. The limited and fragmented nature of the specimen may restrict assessment of invasion or architecture.

### **Curette**

Spoon-shaped instrument for scraping tissue.



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### **Curling Ulcer**

Stress ulceration of the stomach or duodenum associated with severe burns. Part of the Curling triad with hypovolemia and sepsis. The pathogenesis involves reduced mucosal blood flow during the systemic inflammatory response to burn injury.

### **Curling's Ulcer**

An acute peptic ulcer associated with severe burns, often occurring in the duodenum or stomach during physiologic stress.

### **Curvularia Alcornii**

A dematiaceous fungal species causing phaeohyphomycosis, an opportunistic infection of the skin, sinuses, and occasionally the central nervous system in immunocompromised patients. It produces dark, septate hyphae in tissue. Diagnosis is by culture and histopathology showing pigmented fungal elements.

### **Cushing Disease**

Cushing syndrome caused by an adrenocorticotrophic hormone (ACTH)-secreting pituitary tumor. Excess cortisol can cause central weight gain, rounded facial features, skin changes, muscle weakness, high blood pressure, high blood glucose, and menstrual or mood changes.

### **Cushing Syndrome**

Clinical state resulting from chronic exposure to excess glucocorticoids regardless of cause. Most common endogenous cause is Cushing disease from pituitary ACTH-secreting adenoma accounting for approximately seventy percent.

### **Cushing Syndrome Complications**

Untreated Cushing syndrome carries significant morbidity and mortality from cardiovascular disease, infections, thromboembolic events, and metabolic derangements. Cardiovascular complications include accelerated atherosclerosis, hypertension, and dyslipidemia. Infection risk is increased from immunosuppression.

### **Cushing Ulcer**

Stress ulceration associated with central nervous sys-

tem disease, trauma, or surgery. Caused by vagally mediated gastric acid hypersecretion, distinguishing it from Curling ulcer which results from mucosal ischemia. The ulcers are typically solitary, located in the stomach or duodenum, and present with gastrointestinal bleeding.

### **Cushing's Disease**

Hypercortisolism caused specifically by an adrenocorticotrophic-hormone-secreting pituitary adenoma.

### **Cushing's Syndrome**

A disorder caused by prolonged excessive exposure to cortisol, from endogenous overproduction or exogenous glucocorticoid use. Typical features include central weight gain, a round face, dorsocervical fat accumulation, thin skin with easy bruising or purple striae, hypertension, hyperglycaemia, and muscle weakness; untreated disease can cause serious cardiovascular, metabolic, infectious, and bone complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hypercortisolism; cortisol excess syndrome.

### **Cusp Fracture**

Breakage of tooth cusp. Often due to large restoration weakening tooth. Treatment: crown or onlay.

### **Cutaneous Diphtheria**

A skin infection caused by toxigenic or nontoxigenic *Corynebacterium diphtheriae*, producing chronic ulcers or a gray membrane.

### **Cutaneous Drug Eruptions**

a spectrum of reactions. Exanthematous (maculopapular) is the most common, appearing 4 to 14 days after drug initiation. Urticarial appears within hours. Photoallergic occurs at sun-exposed sites. Lichenoid resembles lichen planus.

### **Cutaneous Larva Migrans**

A creeping eruption caused by hookworm larvae (*Ancylostoma braziliense*, *A. caninum*) from dog/cat feces penetrating the skin, typically in tropical/subtropical regions (walking barefoot on con-

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taminated sand). Larvae migrate erratically under the skin causing intensely pruritic, serpiginous, erythematous tracks.

### **Cutaneous Leishmaniasis**

A skin infection caused by *Leishmania* parasites transmitted by sandflies, usually producing one or more chronic ulcers.

### **Cutaneous Lupus**

A form of lupus erythematosus limited to the skin, manifesting as discoid lesions, subacute cutaneous plaques, or acute malar erythema. It may occur in isolation or as a feature of systemic lupus erythematosus.

### **Cutaneous Lupus Erythematosus**

Autoimmune skin disease associated with lupus-spectrum illness and characterized by inflammatory lesions that may scar, alter pigmentation, or cause photosensitivity. Subacute and chronic forms have different morphologies and systemic associations; evaluation may include biopsy, direct immunofluorescence, and autoimmune testing.

### **Cutaneous Lymphoma**

Cutaneous lymphomas are heterogeneous group of T-cell and B-cell malignancies primarily involving the skin. Primary cutaneous B-cell lymphomas include marginal zone lymphoma, follicle center lymphoma, and diffuse large B-cell lymphoma leg type. Primary cutaneous T-cell lymphomas include mycosis fungoides and Sézary syndrome.

### **Cutaneous Metastases**

Secondary deposits of cancer in the skin, originating from a primary tumor elsewhere in the body. They may present as nodules, plaques, or ulcers, and often indicate advanced or recurrent disease.

### **Cutaneous Small-Vessel Vasculitis**

Inflammation and destruction of small dermal blood vessels, commonly presenting as palpable purpura on dependent areas. Causes include infections, medications, autoimmune disease, and systemic vasculitis; skin biopsy with appropriate specimen handling is

central to diagnosis.

### **Cutaneous T-Cell Lymphoma**

A malignancy of skin-homing T lymphocytes. Mycosis fungoides is the most common subtype, presenting as patches, plaques, and tumors in a clothing distribution. Sézary syndrome is the leukemic variant with erythroderma, lymphadenopathy, and circulating malignant cells.

### **Cutting Balloon (Vascular)**

A balloon catheter with small blades or scoring elements that create controlled incisions in plaque during vessel dilation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **CVA**

An abbreviation for cerebrovascular accident, meaning a stroke caused by interruption of blood flow to the brain or bleeding within the brain. It may cause sudden neurologic deficits.

### **Cyanide Poisoning**

Toxicity from cyanide compounds (hydrogen cyanide, potassium/sodium cyanide) that inhibit cytochrome oxidase (complex IV), blocking oxidative phosphorylation and cellular respiration despite adequate oxygen—histotoxic hypoxia. Sources: smoke inhalation (fires—plastic/acrylic), ingestion (industrial, suicidal), occupational exposure.

### **Cyanosis**

A bluish discoloration of the skin and mucous membranes resulting from excessive amounts of deoxygenated hemoglobin in the capillary blood. It becomes clinically apparent when the concentration of deoxygenated hemoglobin exceeds 5 grams per deciliter, which corresponds to an oxygen saturation of approximately 85 percent.

### **Cephalgia**

Headache or pain in the head. It may result from primary headache disorders or from an underlying illness or injury.

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## Cycle Time

Time for complete image acquisition. PET: minutes. SPECT: 20-30 minutes.

## Cyclothymic Disorder

A chronic mood disorder characterized by numerous periods of hypomanic symptoms and periods of depressive symptoms over at least two years (one year in children and adolescents). The hypomanic and depressive symptoms do not meet criteria for a hypomanic or major depressive episode.

## CYP2C19 Polymorphism

CYP2C19 is a cytochrome P450 enzyme involved in the metabolism of approximately 10 percent of drugs, including the antiplatelet agent clopidogrel, proton pump inhibitors, some antidepressants, and the antiepileptic drug phenytoin.

## CYP2D6 Polymorphism

CYP2D6 is a cytochrome P450 enzyme responsible for the metabolism of approximately 25 percent of commonly prescribed drugs, including codeine, tamoxifen, many antidepressants, and antipsychotics.

## CYP450 System

A family of enzymes, found mainly in the liver, that metabolize many medications and other foreign substances. Differences in these enzymes and their inhibition or induction can alter drug effects and toxicity.

## Cyst

A cyst is a closed sac containing fluid, air, cells, or semisolid material and may occur in skin, organs, glands, or other tissues.

## Cystadenoma

A usually benign glandular epithelial tumor that forms cystic spaces or cyst-like structures.

## Cystic Echinococcosis

Hydatid disease: infection with larval cysts of *Echinococcus granulosus* (dog tapeworm), transmitted by ingestion of eggs from dog feces. Cysts

grow slowly in liver (most common, 60-70 percent), lungs (20-30 percent), and other organs. Hepatic: RUQ pain, hepatomegaly, biliary obstruction. Pulmonary: cough, chest pain, hemoptysis.

## Cystic Fibrosis

Autosomal recessive disorder caused by CFTR gene mutations (most common: F508). Defective chloride channel causes thick mucus in lungs, pancreas, liver, reproductive tract. Symptoms: chronic sinusitis, bronchiectasis, pancreatic insufficiency, male infertility (absent vas deferens), meconium ileus.

### Synonyms:

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## Cystic Hygroma

Congenital lymphatic malformation composed of thin-walled lymphatic cysts, manifesting as a soft, fluid-filled, painless, translucent (transilluminates brilliantly) mass, typically in the posterior triangle of the neck (75%, left-sided), axilla (20%), mediastinum, retroperitoneum, or groin.

## Cysticercosis

Cysticercosis is tissue infection by larval *Taenia solium* after swallowing eggs, potentially causing cysts in muscle, skin, eyes, or brain.

## Cystine And Triple Phosphate (Struvite) Crystals

Crystalline substances that may be found in urine sediment. Hexagonal cystine crystals support cystinuria in the appropriate setting, while struvite crystals may occur in infection-related alkaline urine; microscopy is interpreted with clinical and laboratory findings.

### Synonyms:

struvite

## Cystine Stones

Rare stones from inherited cystinuria with defective cystine transport. Hexagonal crystals on urine microscopy. Difficult to dissolve. Treat with aggressive hydration, urine alkalization to pH greater than 7.5, and thiol agents including tiopronin and D-penicillamine that form soluble complexes with

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cystine.

### **Cystinuria**

Cystinuria is an inherited kidney-transport disorder causing excess urinary cystine and recurrent cystine kidney stones.

### **Cystitis**

Inflammation of the urinary bladder, typically from bacterial infection, one of the most common bacterial infections in women.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bladder Infection

### **Cystocele**

Anterior vaginal wall prolapse: herniation of the bladder into the anterior vaginal wall due to weakening of the pubocervical fascia, most commonly after childbirth and menopause.

### **Cystography**

Contrast imaging of bladder. Evaluates trauma, fistulas, vesicoureteral reflux.

### **Cystometrogram**

Suite of diagnostic procedures designed to evaluate the physiological function of the lower urinary tract (bladder and urethral sphincter) during filling, storage, and emptying phases. See urodynamic testing.

### **Cystometry**

A urodynamic test that measures bladder pressure and function during filling and emptying.

### **Cystoscopy**

Cystoscopy uses a camera passed through the urethra to inspect the bladder and urethra and may allow biopsy or treatment.

### **Cystostomy**

Surgical creation of an opening from the urinary bladder to the skin or another structure to permit drainage of urine.

### **Cystourethrography**

Radiographic imaging of the urinary bladder and urethra, usually during filling and voiding after contrast has been introduced.

### **Cytochrome C**

Mobile electron carrier between Complex III and IV. Also involved in apoptosis.

### **Cytochrome P450**

The cytochrome P450 system is a superfamily of heme-containing monooxygenase enzymes primarily located in the endoplasmic reticulum of hepatocytes, responsible for Phase I drug metabolism through oxidation, reduction, and hydrolysis reactions.

### **Cytogenetics**

Study of chromosomes. Detects abnormalities in cancer.

### **Cytogenetics (Karyotype)**

Visualization of chromosomes under light microscopy from dividing cells (bone marrow, blood, amniotic fluid, tissue). Staining: G-banding (Giemsa, light and dark bands). Resolution: 400-550 bands per haploid genome.

#### **Synonyms:**

Karyotype

### **Cytokine**

Small signaling proteins (5-25 kDa) mediating cell-to-cell communication in immunity, inflammation, and hematopoiesis.

### **Cytokine Release Syndrome**

CRS: systemic inflammatory response from massive cytokine release (IL-6, IFN-gamma, TNF, IL-10) after T cell engaging therapies (CAR-T, bispecific antibodies, TGN1412).

### **Cytokine Storm**

A severe, dysregulated systemic inflammatory response involving excessive cytokine release that can cause tissue injury, organ dysfunction, and shock.

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## Cytology

The microscopic study of individual cells, distinct from histology in that tissue architecture is not examined, used for screening and diagnosis of neoplastic and infectious disease. Specimens are exfoliative (cervical smears, sputum) or aspirated (fine needle aspiration, body fluids), interpreted with Papanicolaou or special stains.

## Cytomegalovirus

A herpesvirus that causes significant disease in immunocompromised patients including transplant recipients and HIV-infected individuals. CMV infects a wide range of cell types and establishes latent infections in myeloid progenitor cells. Primary infection is usually asymptomatic in immunocompetent individuals.

## Cytomegalovirus Infection

A widespread herpesvirus infection. Primary infection in immunocompetent individuals is usually asymptomatic or causes mononucleosis-like syndrome. Congenital CMV: most common congenital infection, causes sensorineural hearing loss, microcephaly, and developmental delay.

## Cytopathology

The branch of pathology using cytologic examination of cells to diagnose disease, particularly neoplastic and infectious processes, built on standardized reporting systems that guide management.

## Cerebrospinal Fluid Cytology

Microscopic examination of cells in cerebrospinal fluid to evaluate suspected malignancy, infection, inflammation, or hemorrhage. It is especially useful for detecting leptomeningeal tumor involvement when interpreted with clinical and imaging findings.

## Serous Fluid Cytology

Cytologic examination of pleural, pericardial, or peritoneal fluid to assess for malignant cells, infection, and reactive inflammation. Cell-block preparation and ancillary tests may improve diagnostic accuracy.

## Cytopenia

A reduction in the number of one or more circulating blood-cell lineages: red cells, white cells, or platelets.

## Cytoreductive Surgery

Surgical removal of as much visible tumor as possible to reduce disease burden, a cornerstone of ovarian cancer management and combined with hyperthermic intraperitoneal chemotherapy for peritoneal carcinomatosis.

## Cytoskeleton

Dynamic protein filament network providing structural support, cell shape, intracellular transport, and cell division. Three main components: (1) Microfilaments (actin, 7 nm): cell cortex, stress fibers, contractile ring (cytokinesis), lamellipodia/filopodia (motility), myosin interaction (muscle contraction).

## Cytotoxic T Cell

The effector cells of cell-mediated immunity that kill virus-infected cells and tumor cells. Recognize antigenic peptides presented on MHC class I molecules via the T-cell receptor; co-stimulation by CD4+ helper cells and cytokines (IL-2) is needed for activation.

## Cytotoxicity

The capacity of an immune effector cell or immune mediator to injure or kill a target cell. T lymphocytes and natural killer cells commonly use perforin-granzyme pathways or death-receptor signaling to induce target-cell apoptosis.

## CADASIL Syndrome

An inherited disorder of small brain arteries that can cause migraine with aura, strokes, mood symptoms, and cognitive decline.

## Capnocytophaga Infection

An infection caused by *Capnocytophaga* bacteria, sometimes transmitted through dog or cat bites or scratches.

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### **Carcinomatosis**

Widespread dissemination of carcinoma to multiple surfaces or organs.

### **Cardiac Ablation**

A procedure that destroys a small area of heart tissue causing an abnormal rhythm.

### **Cavernous Hemangioma**

A cluster of enlarged, thin-walled blood vessels that may occur in the skin, brain, or other tissues.

### **Cecostomy**

A surgically created opening from the cecum to the abdominal wall to allow decompression or stool removal.

### **Central Hypothyroidism**

An inadequate thyroid-hormone state caused by insufficient stimulation from the pituitary gland or hypothalamus.

### **Chemoradiotherapy**

Treatment that combines chemotherapy with radiation therapy, often to improve cancer control.

### **Chlamydial Disease**

Infection caused by bacteria of the genus *Chlamydia*, including sexually transmitted and respiratory infections.

### **Chronic Atrophic Gastritis**

Long-term inflammation of the stomach lining that causes loss of gastric glands and may impair vitamin B12 absorption.

### **Ciliary Dyskinesia**

Abnormal movement of cilia that impairs clearance of mucus from the airways and can cause recurrent respiratory infections.

### **Citrullinemia**

An inherited metabolic disorder in which citrulline and ammonia accumulate because of impaired urea-cycle function.

### **Cognitive Behavior Therapy**

A structured psychotherapy that identifies and changes unhelpful thoughts and behaviors.

### **Colonic Inertia**

Markedly slow movement of contents through the colon, causing severe or persistent constipation.

### **Colonic Stenosis**

Narrowing of the colon that may obstruct passage of intestinal contents.

### **Complement Deficiency**

Reduced or absent activity of one or more complement proteins, increasing susceptibility to some infections or autoimmune disease.

### **Complete Cystectomy**

Surgical removal of the entire urinary bladder.

### **Coronary Aneurysm**

Abnormal widening or ballooning of a coronary artery.

### **Crescentic Glomerulonephritis**

A rapidly progressive kidney inflammation in which crescent-shaped lesions form in the glomeruli.

### **Cryoglobulinemia**

Cryoglobulinemia occurs when abnormal proteins precipitate in the cold and can cause blood-vessel inflammation, rash, nerve disease, kidney injury, or hyperviscosity.

### **Cyclic Neutropenia**

Recurrent episodes of abnormally low neutrophil counts occurring at regular intervals.

### **Cyclooxygenase Inhibitor**

A medicine that reduces production of prostaglandins and may relieve pain and inflammation.



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## **Callus**

A localized area of thickened, hardened skin caused by repeated pressure or friction.

## **Cancellous Bone**

Porous, trabecular bone found inside many bones, especially near joints and in the vertebrae.

## **Capillaries**

The smallest blood vessels, where oxygen, nutrients, and waste products move between blood and tissues.

## **Capsaicin**

A compound from chili peppers used in some topical medicines to reduce certain types of pain.

## **Carbon Monoxide**

A colorless, odorless gas that can prevent blood from carrying oxygen and cause life-threatening poisoning.

## **Carcinogenesis**

The process by which normal cells acquire changes that lead to cancer.

## **Cardiac Myocytes**

Muscle cells of the heart that generate force for cardiac contraction.

## **Cardiopulmonary Bypass**

A technique that temporarily circulates and oxygenates blood during some heart operations.

## **Cardiovascular**

A clinical condition or finding involving cardiovascular. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Carotid Duplex Doppler Scanning**

An ultrasound examination that assesses the structure and blood flow of the carotid arteries.

## **Cartilaginous Joint**

A joint in which bones are connected by cartilage

and allow limited movement.

## **Cataplexy**

Sudden temporary loss of muscle tone triggered by strong emotion, commonly associated with narcolepsy.

## **Celiac Plexus**

A network of nerves in the upper abdomen that supplies abdominal organs and may be targeted for pain treatment.

## **Chronic Pain Syndrome**

Persistent pain accompanied by significant physical, emotional, or social effects that interfere with daily life.

## **Cilia**

Small hair-like structures on cells that move fluid, particles, or mucus across a tissue surface.

## **Classic Migraine**

A migraine associated with an aura, such as temporary visual or sensory symptoms.

## **Clot Buster**

A medicine that dissolves a blood clot; the medical term is thrombolytic.

## **Cognitive Reserve**

The brain's ability to use alternative strategies or networks to maintain function despite injury or disease.

## **Colorectal Adenoma**

A gland-forming growth in the colon or rectum that may develop into colorectal cancer.

## **Complement System**

A group of blood proteins that supports immune defense by destroying microbes and promoting inflammation and phagocytosis.

## **Compression Fracture**

Collapse of a vertebra or other bone because of com-

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pression, often related to osteoporosis or trauma.

### **Conception**

The beginning of pregnancy, usually referring to fertilization and the subsequent establishment of pregnancy.

### **Condyle**

A rounded projection at the end of a bone that contributes to a joint.

### **Crohn's Disease**

A chronic inflammatory bowel disease that can cause patchy, transmural inflammation anywhere from the mouth to the anus, most often involving the terminal ileum or colon. Common features include abdominal cramping or pain, persistent diarrhoea, weight loss, fatigue, fever, anaemia, and extraintestinal inflammation of the joints, eyes, or skin.

#### **Synonyms:**

Crohn Disease (Crohn's Disease) Ileitis (Crohn's Disease)

### **Crystalline Lens**

The transparent flexible structure inside the eye that focuses light onto the retina.

### **Cystoid Macular Edema**

Swelling of the macula caused by fluid collecting in small cyst-like spaces within the retina.

### **C. Difficile Infection**

Infection with *Clostridioides difficile* bacteria, often causing antibiotic-associated diarrhea and colitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

C. Diff

### **Carcinoma Of Unknown Primary**

Cancer that has spread but whose original site cannot be identified despite evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer Of Unknown Origin Occult Primary Cancer

### **Cavernous Malformations**

Abnormally enlarged, thin-walled blood-vessel clus-

ters that can bleed or cause neurological symptoms.

### **Cavities And Tooth Decay**

Progressive destruction of tooth enamel and deeper tooth tissues by acids produced by oral bacteria.

### **Central Nervous System Lymphoma**

A lymphoma that begins in the brain, spinal cord, eye, or cerebrospinal fluid.

### **Central Nervous System Vascular Malformations**

Abnormal blood-vessel formations in or around the brain or spinal cord.

### **Chronic Daily Headaches**

Headaches occurring on at least 15 days each month for more than three months.

### **Chronic Hives**

Recurrent itchy welts that occur on most days for more than six weeks.

### **Chronic Pelvic Pain**

Persistent or recurrent pain in the lower abdomen or pelvis lasting at least six months.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pelvic Pain, Chronic

### **Chronic Traumatic Encephalopathy**

A progressive brain disorder associated with repeated head impacts and characterized by cognitive, mood, or behavioral changes.

### **Cold Urticaria**

Hives or swelling triggered by exposure of the skin to cold.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cold Allergy

### **Colon Polyps**

Growths arising from the inner lining of the colon; some types can develop into colorectal cancer.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Polyps, Colon Polyps Colon (Colon Polyps) Polyps  
Rectal (Colon Polyps)

### **Common Cold In Babies**

A viral infection of an infant's upper respiratory tract that commonly causes a runny nose, congestion, and cough.

### **Compulsive Sexual Behavior**

Recurrent sexual thoughts or behaviors that are difficult to control and cause significant distress or impairment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sexual Obsession

### **Congenital Heart Defects**

Structural abnormalities of the heart or major blood vessels that are present at birth. They range from minor defects to critical conditions requiring early intervention.

### **Congenital Heart Defects In Children**

Structural abnormalities of the heart or major blood vessels present at birth.

### **Congenital Heart Disease In Adults**

A heart defect present from birth that persists into adulthood or causes complications later in life.

### **Congenital Mitral Valve Anomalies**

Structural abnormalities of the mitral valve that are present at birth and may impair blood flow.

### **Congenital Myasthenic Syndromes**

A group of inherited disorders that impair communication between nerves and muscles, causing fatigable weakness.

### **Constipation In Children**

Infrequent, hard, or painful bowel movements in a child.

### **Cough Headaches**

Headaches triggered by coughing, sneezing, straining, or other sudden increases in pressure in the

head.

### **Cutaneous B-Cell Lymphoma**

A type of non-Hodgkin lymphoma that primarily affects B lymphocytes in the skin.

### **Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome**

Recurrent episodes of severe vomiting separated by symptom-free intervals.

### **Cyclosporiasis**

An intestinal infection caused by the parasite *Cyclospora cayetanensis*, usually acquired by consuming contaminated food or water. It commonly causes prolonged or relapsing watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, fatigue, loss of appetite, and weight loss; diagnosis requires specialized stool testing, and trimethoprim-sulfamethoxazole is the usual effective treatment when appropriate.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyclospora Infection (Cyclosporiasis)

### **Cyclothymia**

A long-term mood disorder with repeated periods of hypomanic and depressive symptoms that do not meet criteria for full episodes.

### **Cholestasis Of Pregnancy**

A liver disorder of pregnancy in which impaired bile flow causes itching and elevated bile acids.

#### **Synonyms:**

Obstetric Cholestasis

### **Choroid Plexus Carcinoma**

A malignant tumor arising from the choroid plexus, the tissue that produces cerebrospinal fluid.

### **Chemo Brain**

Subjective difficulties with memory, attention, or thinking that occur during or after cancer treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Post-Chemotherapy Cognitive Impairment

### **Chest Tube**

A flexible tube inserted into the pleural space to

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remove air, blood, or fluid and help the lung re-expand.

### **Culture**

A laboratory test in which a clinical specimen is placed in conditions that allow microorganisms to grow and be identified; susceptibility testing may help guide treatment.

### **Calvaria**

The dome-shaped upper portion of the skull that protects the brain.

### **Calyx**

A cup-shaped structure that collects fluid or supports an organ. In the kidney, renal calyces collect urine from the renal pyramids and convey it to the renal pelvis.

### **Cannula**

A hollow tube inserted into a blood vessel, body cavity, or tissue to deliver or remove fluids or to provide access for instruments.

### **Canthotomy**

A surgical incision through the outer canthus of the eyelids, usually performed urgently to relieve pressure in the orbit.

### **Canthus**

The angle where the upper and lower eyelids meet.

### **Carbon Dioxide**

A colorless gas produced by cellular metabolism and removed mainly by the lungs during exhalation.

### **Cardia**

The part of the stomach surrounding the opening where the esophagus joins the stomach.

### **Cast**

A rigid or semi-rigid device applied around an injured limb or joint to immobilize it while bone or soft tissue heals.

### **Cauterization**

The deliberate destruction or sealing of tissue using heat, electricity, chemicals, or another energy source to control bleeding or remove abnormal tissue.

### **Chlamydia Trachomatis**

A bacterium that commonly causes sexually transmitted infection of the urogenital tract and can also cause conjunctivitis or pneumonia.

### **Clamp**

A surgical instrument used to grasp, compress, occlude, or hold tissue, blood vessels, tubing, or other structures.

### **Clean-Catch Specimen**

A urine sample collected after cleansing the surrounding area and beginning urination, with the middle portion collected in a sterile container to reduce contamination.

### **Colposcope**

A lighted, magnifying instrument used to examine the cervix, vagina, or vulva in detail.

### **Continuous Bladder Irrigation**

Continuous instillation of sterile fluid through a urinary catheter to keep the bladder catheter patent and remove blood clots or debris.

### **Continuous Subcutaneous Insulin Infusion**

Delivery of rapid-acting insulin through a pump and a subcutaneous infusion set to provide basal insulin and mealtime doses.

### **Convergence**

The inward movement of both eyes so that they are directed toward the same nearby object.

### **Creatine**

A nitrogen-containing compound stored mainly in skeletal muscle that helps supply energy for short, high-intensity activity.

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### **Cross-Matching**

A laboratory test that checks donor and recipient blood for compatibility before transfusion.

### **Cystoscope**

A thin, lighted instrument used to examine the urethra and bladder and, when needed, perform procedures.

### **Cystotome**

A surgical instrument used to make an incision in the capsule of the lens during selected eye procedures.

### **Cancer Grading**

Assessment of how abnormal cancer cells appear under a microscope and how aggressively the tumor is likely to behave. It differs from cancer staging, which describes the extent of spread.

### **C1 Esterase Inhibitor**

A plasma protein that regulates the complement, kallikrein-kinin, and coagulation pathways. Deficiency or dysfunction can cause hereditary angioedema.

### **C1Q Nephropathy**

A glomerular disease characterized by dominant or codominant deposits of the complement component C1q in glomeruli, with variable proteinuria and kidney dysfunction.

### **Café Coronary**

Sudden airway obstruction by food, usually occurring while eating and sometimes causing collapse or death if the airway is not rapidly cleared.

### **Calcific Tendinitis**

Deposition of calcium hydroxyapatite crystals within a tendon, most often the rotator cuff, causing acute pain and restricted movement.

### **Callosotomy**

Surgical division of the corpus callosum to reduce the spread of certain severe, treatment-resistant seizures between the cerebral hemispheres.

### **Candidal Vaginitis**

Inflammation of the vagina caused by overgrowth of *Candida* yeast, usually producing itching, soreness, and a thick white discharge.

### **Caffeine Intoxication**

A toxic state caused by excessive caffeine exposure, characterized by symptoms such as restlessness, nervousness, insomnia, rapid heartbeat, tremor, gastrointestinal upset, or agitation.

### **Café-Au-Lait Macules**

Flat, light-brown skin patches with relatively uniform pigmentation. Multiple lesions may be associated with genetic disorders such as neurofibromatosis type 1.

### **Cerebral Vasospasm**

Abnormal narrowing of cerebral arteries that can reduce brain perfusion and cause delayed cerebral ischemia, especially after aneurysmal subarachnoid hemorrhage.

### **Cervical Myelopathy**

Dysfunction of the spinal cord caused by compression in the cervical spine, often producing hand clumsiness, gait disturbance, weakness, sensory changes, or abnormal reflexes.

### **Cardiac Arrhythmias**

Abnormalities of the heart rate or rhythm caused by disturbances in impulse formation or conduction. They include tachycardia, bradycardia, and irregular rhythms.

### **Cerebral Thrombosis**

Formation of a blood clot within a cerebral artery, reducing blood flow and potentially causing an ischemic stroke.

### **Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia (CIN)**

Abnormal precancerous changes in the squamous cells of the cervix, usually associated with persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection. CIN is graded by the severity of dysplasia.

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**Synonyms:**  
CIN

### **Chilblains (Pernio)**

Itchy, painful, red or purplish inflammatory lesions caused by an abnormal response of small blood vessels to cold and subsequent rewarming.

**Synonyms:**  
Pernio

### **Cognition**

The mental processes involved in acquiring, storing, retrieving, and using information, including attention, memory, language, reasoning, and judgment.

### **Compound Fracture (Open Fracture)**

A fracture associated with a wound that communicates between the fracture site and the external environment. It carries increased risks of infection and tissue damage.

**Synonyms:**  
Open Fracture

### **Conversion Disorder (Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder)**

A condition in which neurological symptoms, such as weakness, abnormal movements, sensory loss, or seizures, are not explained by a recognized structural neurological disease and cause significant impairment.

**Synonyms:**  
Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder

### **Corneal Graft (Corneal Transplant)**

Surgical replacement of part or all of a diseased or damaged cornea with donor corneal tissue to restore vision or relieve pain.

**Synonyms:**  
Corneal Transplant

### **Coronary Care Unit (CCU)**

A specialized hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and treatment for patients with serious acute cardiac conditions.

**Synonyms:**

CCU

### **Crepitation (Crepitus)**

A crackling, grating, or popping sensation or sound produced by movement of tissues, air, or bone. Causes include fractures, joint disease, subcutaneous air, and lung disease.

**Synonyms:**  
Crepitus

### **CABG**

Coronary artery bypass grafting, a surgical procedure that creates a route around a narrowed or blocked coronary artery to improve blood flow to heart muscle.

**Synonyms:**  
Coronary artery bypass grafting; coronary bypass surgery.

### **Cardiac**

Relating to the heart.

**Synonyms:**  
Heart-related; cardiac-related.

### **Cardiopulmonary**

Relating to the heart and lungs or to their combined function.

**Synonyms:**  
Cardiorespiratory.

### **Cardiopulmonary Bypass Machine**

A machine that temporarily circulates and oxygenates blood during selected heart or major-vessel operations while the heart and lungs are not performing their usual functions.

**Synonyms:**  
Heart-lung machine; cardiopulmonary bypass pump.

### **Cardiorespiratory Endurance**

The ability of the heart, lungs, and circulation to deliver oxygen during sustained physical activity.

**Synonyms:**  
Cardiorespiratory fitness; aerobic endurance.



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### **Carminative**

A substance traditionally used to reduce intestinal gas or discomfort by promoting passage of gas through the digestive tract.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antiflatulent; gas-relieving agent.

### **Carotenoids**

Plant pigments, including beta-carotene, that contribute yellow, orange, or red color and may have antioxidant or provitamin-A activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Carotenoid pigments; provitamin-A pigments.

### **Catagen**

The transitional phase of the hair-growth cycle between active growth and resting.

#### **Synonyms:**

Catagen phase; regression phase of hair growth.

### **Catastrophic Reaction**

A disproportionately intense emotional or behavioral response to a situation that may appear minor to others, often occurring with cognitive impairment or neurologic disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Catastrophic response; catastrophic emotional reaction.

### **Cathartic**

An agent that promotes bowel evacuation, usually by increasing stool water, intestinal motility, or both.

#### **Synonyms:**

Purgative; laxative.

### **Cation**

An ion with a positive electrical charge, such as sodium, potassium, calcium, or hydrogen.

#### **Synonyms:**

Positively charged ion.

### **Cauda Equina**

The bundle of lumbar, sacral, and coccygeal nerve roots below the end of the spinal cord.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cauda equina nerve roots; horse-tail nerve bundle.

### **Causalgia**

Severe persistent burning pain and sensory disturbance caused by injury to a peripheral nerve, now commonly classified within complex regional pain syndrome type II.

#### **Synonyms:**

Complex regional pain syndrome type II; causalgic pain.

### **Cavity**

A localized hole or structural defect in a tooth caused by dental caries.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental cavity; carious lesion.

### **CBC**

A blood test that measures red cells, white cells, hemoglobin, hematocrit, and platelets.

#### **Synonyms:**

Complete blood count; full blood count.

### **CCU**

A hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and specialized treatment for people with serious acute cardiac disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Coronary care unit; cardiac care unit.

### **Cell Senescence**

A state in which a cell remains metabolically active but permanently stops dividing, often in response to aging, stress, or cellular damage.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cellular senescence; replicative senescence.

### **Central (Brain) Fatigue**

A sense of reduced mental energy, concentration, alertness, or motivation arising primarily from central nervous-system processes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Central fatigue; mental fatigue.

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### Cerebrovascular

Relating to the blood vessels and circulation of the brain.

**Synonyms:**

Brain-vascular; cerebral vascular.

### Cervicogenic Headache

A headache caused by a disorder of the cervical spine or its soft tissues, with pain referred from the neck to the head.

**Synonyms:**

Cervical headache; neck-related headache.

### CFS

Chronic fatigue syndrome, a condition involving substantial persistent fatigue with post-exertional worsening and associated symptoms that are not explained by another disorder.

**Synonyms:**

Chronic fatigue syndrome; myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome.

### Challenge Testing

A controlled exposure to a suspected trigger, such as a food or medication, to assess whether it produces a reproducible reaction.

**Synonyms:**

Provocation testing; challenge test.

### Chemical Peel

Application of a chemical solution to the skin to produce controlled exfoliation and regeneration of superficial or deeper skin layers.

**Synonyms:**

Chemexfoliation; chemical resurfacing.

### Chemonucleolysis

An intradiscal treatment intended to dissolve part of a herniated intervertebral disk, historically using an enzyme preparation.

**Synonyms:**

Enzymatic disk dissolution; chemonucleolysis procedure.

### Chiropractor

A healthcare practitioner who provides manual or manipulative treatment, especially for musculoskeletal conditions, according to the practitioner's training and local regulation.

**Synonyms:**

Chiropractic practitioner; chiropractic clinician.

### Chlorophyllin

A water-soluble, copper-containing derivative of chlorophyll used in some products and studied for effects such as odor control; clinical uses depend on evidence and context.

**Synonyms:**

Chlorophyllin copper complex; sodium copper chlorophyllin.

### Cholagogue

A substance that promotes emptying of the gallbladder into the intestine.

**Synonyms:**

Gallbladder stimulant; biliary evacuant.

### Choleretic

A substance that promotes production or secretion of bile by the liver.

**Synonyms:**

Bile-secretory agent; bile-flow stimulant.

### Cholesterol

A lipid required for cell membranes and synthesis of steroid hormones and bile acids. Excess atherogenic cholesterol can contribute to arterial plaque.

**Synonyms:**

Serum cholesterol; blood cholesterol.

### Cholinergic Neuron

A nerve cell that releases acetylcholine as its principal neurotransmitter.

**Synonyms:**

Acetylcholine-releasing neuron; cholinergic nerve cell.

### Chondrocyte

A mature cartilage cell that produces and maintains

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the cartilage extracellular matrix.

**Synonyms:**

Cartilage cell.

**Chronic Paroxysmal Hemicrania**

A primary headache disorder causing frequent, short-lasting, severe one-sided headaches with autonomic symptoms and a characteristic response to indomethacin.

**Synonyms:**

CPH; chronic paroxysmal hemicrania syndrome.

**Chyme**

A semifluid mixture of partially digested food and gastric or intestinal secretions that passes from the stomach into the small intestine.

**Synonyms:**

Digestive chyme; gastric chyme.

**Cicatricial Alopecia**

Hair loss caused by destruction and scarring of hair follicles, usually leading to permanent loss in affected areas.

**Synonyms:**

Scarring alopecia; cicatricial hair loss.

**CK**

Creatine kinase, an enzyme found in skeletal muscle, heart muscle, and brain whose blood level may rise after tissue injury.

**Synonyms:**

Creatine phosphokinase; creatine kinase enzyme.

**Clonal Expansion**

Rapid multiplication of genetically or immunologically related cells derived from a single precursor after activation.

**Synonyms:**

Clonal proliferation; clone expansion.

**Coagulate**

To change from a liquid to a semisolid or solid state, especially the formation of a blood clot through coagulation.

**Synonyms:**

Clot; clot formation.

**Cognitive Function**

The mental processes involved in attention, memory, language, reasoning, learning, judgment, and problem solving.

**Synonyms:**

Cognition; cognitive ability.

**Collagenase**

An enzyme that breaks down collagen in connective tissue.

**Synonyms:**

Collagen-digesting enzyme; collagen-degrading enzyme.

**Combined Hormone Therapy**

Hormone therapy containing both estrogen and a progestogen, generally used when endometrial protection is needed in a person with a uterus.

**Synonyms:**

Estrogen-progestogen therapy; combined menopausal hormone therapy.

**Combined Hyperlipidemia**

A lipid disorder characterized by elevated cholesterol and triglycerides, often with increased atherogenic lipoproteins.

**Synonyms:**

Mixed hyperlipidemia; combined hyperlipoproteinemia.

**Common Migraine**

A migraine without a preceding aura.

**Synonyms:**

Migraine without aura; migraine without neurologic aura.

**Compact Bone**

Dense outer bone tissue organized into osteons that provides strength and structural support.

**Synonyms:**

Cortical bone; dense bone.

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### **Complicated Migraine**

An older, nonspecific term for migraine accompanied by prolonged or prominent neurologic symptoms; the specific syndrome should be identified when possible.

#### **Synonyms:**

Migraine with prolonged neurologic symptoms; complex migraine, historical usage.

### **Compounding Pharmacy**

A pharmacy that prepares customized formulations for an individual patient when a suitable commercially manufactured product is unavailable or unsuitable.

#### **Synonyms:**

Compounding pharmacy practice; extemporaneous pharmacy.

### **Cones**

Retinal photoreceptor cells responsible for color vision and detailed vision in relatively bright light.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cone photoreceptors; cone cells.

### **Conjugate Vaccine**

A vaccine in which a poorly immunogenic polysaccharide antigen is linked to a carrier protein to improve the immune response, especially in infants and young children.

#### **Synonyms:**

Protein-conjugate vaccine; conjugated polysaccharide vaccine.

### **Conjugated Equine Estrogens**

A mixture of estrogenic compounds historically derived from the urine of pregnant mares and used in some hormone-therapy formulations.

#### **Synonyms:**

CEE; conjugated estrogens.

### **Continuous Combined Hormone Therapy**

A hormone regimen in which estrogen and progesterone are taken continuously rather than sequentially.

#### **Synonyms:**

Continuous combined HRT; continuous estrogen-

progesterone therapy.

### **Contractile Proteins**

Proteins, especially actin and myosin, that interact to generate force and shorten muscle cells.

#### **Synonyms:**

Muscle contractile proteins; actomyosin proteins.

### **Contrast Medium**

A substance administered or placed in the body to make tissues, organs, or body spaces more visible during imaging.

#### **Synonyms:**

Contrast agent; radiographic contrast material.

### **Controllers**

Long-term asthma medicines taken regularly to reduce airway inflammation and prevent symptoms or exacerbations.

#### **Synonyms:**

Controller medicines; maintenance asthma therapy.

### **Convulsion**

A sudden episode of involuntary, often rhythmic muscle contractions that may occur with a seizure or other disturbance of brain function.

#### **Synonyms:**

Convulsive episode; seizure-related motor activity.

### **Corn**

A localized thickening of skin caused by repeated pressure or friction, often occurring on the toes or feet.

#### **Synonyms:**

Clavus; heloma.

### **Coronary**

Relating to the arteries or circulation that supply the heart muscle.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardiac blood-vessel-related; heart-coronary.

### **Coronary Artery Bypass Surgery**

Surgery that uses a graft to route blood around a narrowed or blocked coronary artery.

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**Synonyms:**

CABG; coronary bypass surgery.

**Coronary Endarterectomy**

Surgical removal of atherosclerotic plaque from the inner lining of a coronary artery.

**Synonyms:**

Coronary plaque endarterectomy; coronary endarterectomy procedure.

**Coronary Spasm**

Temporary contraction of a coronary artery that reduces blood flow to the heart muscle and may cause angina or infarction.

**Synonyms:**

Vasospastic angina mechanism; coronary artery spasm.

**Coronary Care Unit**

A hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and specialized care for acute cardiac illness.

**Synonyms:**

CCU; cardiac care unit.

**Corpus Cavernosum**

One of two columns of erectile tissue in the penis that fill with blood during erection.

**Synonyms:**

Cavernous body; penile corpus cavernosum.

**Corpus Luteum**

The temporary endocrine structure formed from an ovarian follicle after ovulation; it produces progesterone during the luteal phase and early pregnancy.

**Synonyms:**

Yellow body; luteal body.

**Corpus Spongiosum**

A column of erectile tissue surrounding the penile urethra and expanding distally to form the glans.

**Synonyms:**

Spongy body; corpus spongiosum penis.

**Corrugator Muscle**

A small facial muscle that draws the eyebrows down-

ward and inward, contributing to frowning.

**Synonyms:**

Corrugator supercilii; glabellar muscle.

**Cortex**

The outer layer of an organ or structure, such as the cerebral cortex, adrenal cortex, or outer layer of a hair shaft.

**Synonyms:**

Cortical layer; outer cortex.

**Cortical Bone**

Dense bone forming the outer shell of most bones and providing much of the skeleton's mechanical strength.

**Synonyms:**

Compact bone; cortical tissue.

**Corticotropin-Releasing Factor**

A hypothalamic hormone that stimulates the pituitary gland to release adrenocorticotrophic hormone and helps coordinate the stress response.

**Synonyms:**

Corticotropin-releasing hormone; CRH.

**COX-2 Inhibitors**

Medicines that inhibit cyclooxygenase-2, an enzyme involved in prostaglandin production and inflammation.

**Synonyms:**

Cyclooxygenase-2 inhibitors; selective COX-2 inhibitors.

**CPR**

CPR is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

**Craving**

A strong, often difficult-to-control desire for a substance, behavior, or experience, commonly seen in substance-use disorders.

**Synonyms:**

Strong urge; compulsive desire.

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### **Creatinine Test**

A blood or urine test measuring creatinine to help assess kidney filtration and muscle-related creatinine production.

#### **Synonyms:**

Creatinine measurement; renal function creatinine test.

### **Crepitus**

A crackling, grating, or popping sensation or sound caused by movement of tissue, bone, joint surfaces, or air in soft tissue.

#### **Synonyms:**

Crepitation; crackling sensation.

### **Crown**

The visible part of a tooth above the gum line, or a dental restoration that covers and protects a damaged tooth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental crown; anatomic tooth crown.

### **CT**

Computed tomography, an imaging method that uses multiple X-ray measurements and computer reconstruction to produce cross-sectional images.

#### **Synonyms:**

Computed tomography; CAT scan.

### **Cupping**

An abnormal enlargement or depression of the optic-disc cup, often assessed in evaluating glaucoma.

#### **Synonyms:**

Optic-disc cupping; glaucomatous cupping.

### **Cuticle**

The thin outermost layer of a hair shaft formed by overlapping cells that protect the inner cortex.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hair cuticle; cuticular layer.

### **Cyclic Guanosine Monophosphate**

A cellular signaling molecule involved in smooth-muscle relaxation, phototransduction, and other physiologic processes.

#### **Synonyms:**

cGMP; cyclic GMP.

### **Cyclic Hormone Therapy**

Hormone therapy in which estrogen is given continuously or for part of a cycle and progestogen is added for a defined number of days.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sequential hormone therapy; cyclic estrogen-progestogen therapy.

### **Cyclooxygenase**

An enzyme family that helps convert arachidonic acid into prostaglandins and related mediators involved in pain, inflammation, and platelet function.

#### **Synonyms:**

COX enzyme; prostaglandin-endoperoxide synthase.

### **Cytokines**

Small signaling proteins released by immune and other cells that regulate inflammation, immunity, blood-cell production, and tissue responses.

#### **Synonyms:**

Immune signaling proteins; cytokine mediators.

### **Cytotoxic Alopecia**

Hair loss caused by exposure to a cytotoxic treatment or other toxic injury to actively growing hair follicles.

#### **Synonyms:**

Drug-induced alopecia; chemotherapy-related hair loss.

### **C Fiber**

A biological or biochemical term referring to c fiber. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Cabazitaxel**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cabazitaxel. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Cabergoline**

A clinical condition or finding involving cabergo-



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line. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cadherin**

A calcium-dependent cell-adhesion protein that links neighboring cells and helps organize tissues; abnormal cadherin expression can promote invasion and metastasis in cancer.

### **Cadmium**

A toxic heavy metal found in tobacco smoke, batteries, pigments, and contaminated food; chronic exposure can injure the kidneys, lungs, and bones and increases cancer risk.

### **Cadmium Chloride**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cadmium chloride. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Cadusafos**

An organophosphate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase; exposure can cause cholinergic poisoning with sweating, salivation, vomiting, weakness, breathing difficulty, or seizures.

### **Caenorhabditis Elegans**

A biomedical term referring to *caenorhabditis elegans*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Cafe-Au-Lait Spot**

A flat, evenly pigmented light-brown skin macule; several lesions or characteristic size and distribution may suggest neurofibromatosis type 1 or another genetic disorder.

### **Caffeic Acid**

A plant-derived phenolic compound found in coffee, fruit, and vegetables; it participates in plant metabolism and is studied experimentally for antioxidant and other biologic effects.

### **Calbindin**

A calcium-binding protein that buffers intracellular calcium and supports signaling, especially in neurons and intestinal epithelial cells; it is also used as a tissue marker.

### **Calcifediol**

25-hydroxyvitamin D, the major circulating storage form of vitamin D measured to assess vitamin-D status before activation to calcitriol.

### **Calcineurin**

A calcium- and calmodulin-dependent phosphatase that activates NFAT transcription factors; calcineurin inhibitors such as cyclosporine suppress T-cell activation.

### **Calcitriol**

The hormonally active form of vitamin D, produced by renal and other tissues, that increases intestinal calcium and phosphate absorption and regulates parathyroid hormone and bone metabolism.

### **Calcium Carbonate**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by calcium carbonate. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Calcium Channel**

A biological or biochemical term referring to calcium channel. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Calcium Chloride**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by calcium chloride. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Calcium Citrate**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by calcium citrate. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Calcium Gluconate**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by

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calcium gluconate. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Calcium Signaling**

A biological or biochemical term referring to calcium signaling. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Calculi**

Hardened mineral concretions, such as gallstones, kidney stones, or salivary stones, formed when dissolved substances precipitate and aggregate within a body organ or duct.

### **Calibration**

Calibration is used in relation to calibration during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Caliciviridae**

Caliciviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Calmodulin**

An intracellular calcium-binding messenger protein that changes shape when it binds calcium and regulates enzymes, ion channels, muscle contraction, and gene expression.

### **Calnexin**

An endoplasmic-reticulum chaperone that binds newly synthesized glycoproteins and helps them fold correctly before they are transported or degraded.

### **Calories**

Units used to express the energy supplied by food or expended by the body; food labels generally report kilocalories, commonly called calories.

### **Calorimetry**

Calorimetry is used in relation to calorimetry during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Calpain**

Calpain is used in relation to calpain during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Calponin**

An actin-associated protein in smooth muscle and other cells that modulates contraction and cytoskeletal organization; immunostaining can help identify myoid differentiation.

### **Calreticulin**

An endoplasmic-reticulum chaperone and calcium-binding protein involved in protein folding and immune signaling; CALR mutations are associated with some myeloproliferative neoplasms.

### **Calretinin**

A calcium-binding protein expressed in selected neurons, mesothelial cells, and other tissues; immunohistochemical staining helps distinguish mesothelioma from some carcinomas.

### **Calvarium**

The dome-like portion of the skull formed mainly by the frontal, parietal, and occipital bones that encloses and protects the cerebral hemispheres.

### **Campesterol**

A plant sterol structurally related to cholesterol that is absorbed in small amounts from food; elevated absorption can contribute to rare sitosterolemia.

### **Camphor**

A fragrant bicyclic compound used in topical products and some traditional remedies; ingestion can cause nausea, agitation, seizures, and potentially fatal toxicity.

### **Campomelic Dysplasia**

A disorder, malformation, or clinical finding involving the body structure or process named by the term; diagnosis uses its characteristic pattern, history, examination, and appropriate testing.

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## Camptothecin

A plant-derived compound that inhibits topoisomerase I by stabilizing the enzyme–DNA cleavage complex; related drugs include irinotecan and topotecan.

## Camptothecin Analogue

A drug structurally related to camptothecin that inhibits topoisomerase I, disrupting DNA replication and causing cancer-cell death; toxicity commonly includes marrow or gastrointestinal effects.

## Campylobacter

Campylobacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Coli

Campylobacter coli is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Concisus

Campylobacter concisus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Curvus

Campylobacter curvus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Fetus

Campylobacter fetus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Gracilis

Campylobacter gracilis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Jejuni

Campylobacter jejuni is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Lari

Campylobacter lari is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Rectus

Campylobacter rectus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacter Upsaliensis

Campylobacter upsaliensis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Campylobacteraceae

Campylobacteraceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Canagliflozin

An SGLT2 inhibitor that lowers blood glucose by increasing urinary glucose excretion and also reduces selected heart-failure and kidney risks; adverse ef-

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fects include genital infections and ketoacidosis.

### **Canarypox Virus**

Canarypox virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Cancell**

A shortened or misspelled form of cancellous, referring to the porous, trabecular interior of bone that contains marrow and helps distribute mechanical load.

### **Cancer Cluster**

A neoplastic process affecting cancer cluster; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cancer Immunotherapy**

Cancer immunotherapy is used in relation to cancer immunotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Cancer Prevention**

A neoplastic process affecting cancer prevention; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cancer Risk**

A neoplastic process affecting cancer risk; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Candela**

The SI unit of luminous intensity in a specified direction; it is used in photometry and is distinct from medical measures of light dose or illuminance.

### **Candida**

Candida is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Albicans**

Candida albicans is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Boidinii**

Candida boidinii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Dubliniensis**

Candida dubliniensis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Esophagitis**

Candida esophagitis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Famata**

Candida famata is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Glabrata**

Candida glabrata is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Inconspicua**

Candida inconspicua is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

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pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Intermedia**

Candida intermedia is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Orthopsilosis**

Candida orthopsilosis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Parapsilosis**

Candida parapsilosis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Sake**

Candida sake is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Tropicalis**

Candida tropicalis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Candida Zeylanoides**

Candida zeylanoides is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Canertinib Dihydrochloride**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by canertinib dihydrochloride. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Canfosfamide Hcl**

An investigational glutathione-S-transferase P1-1-activated anticancer prodrug studied for tumor-selective cytotoxicity; it is not a routine approved treatment.

### **Cannabidiol**

A nonintoxicating cannabinoid from Cannabis sativa that influences several signaling systems; purified cannabidiol is used for selected seizure disorders, while products vary in quality and interactions.

### **Cannabinoid**

A compound that acts on cannabinoid receptors or related targets, including plant cannabinoids, endogenous endocannabinoids, and synthetic agents; effects vary from analgesia and appetite change to intoxication.

### **Cannabinoid Receptor**

A G-protein-coupled receptor, chiefly CB1 or CB2, activated by endocannabinoids and some cannabis compounds to modulate pain, appetite, mood, memory, immunity, and inflammation.

### **Cannabinol**

A mildly psychoactive cannabinoid produced as THC oxidizes; its clinical effects and therapeutic usefulness remain less established than those of several other cannabinoids.

### **Cannula Hub**

The proximal connector of a cannula that joins it to tubing, a syringe, or another device and may contain a port or valve for access and fluid delivery.

### **Canola Oil**

A vegetable oil low in saturated fat and relatively rich in monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fatty

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acids, commonly used as a cooking oil.

### **Canrenone**

An active metabolite and potassium-sparing antimineralocorticoid related to spironolactone that antagonizes aldosterone at the mineralocorticoid receptor.

### **Canthaxanthin**

A red-orange carotenoid pigment used as a color additive and formerly in tanning products; excessive ingestion can cause retinal crystal deposits and liver injury.

### **Cantuzumab Ravtansine**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cantuzumab ravtansine. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Capecitabine**

An oral prodrug converted in tissues to 5-fluorouracil, used for selected solid tumors; important toxicities include diarrhea, mucositis, hand-foot syndrome, and cardiotoxicity.

### **Capillaria**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with capillaria. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Capillaria Philippinensis**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with capillaria philippinensis. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Capillary Electrophoresis**

A diagnostic test or assessment related to capillary electrophoresis. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Capillary Plasma**

The liquid component of blood obtained from small vessels in skin or tissue, containing water, elec-

trolytes, proteins, hormones, nutrients, and waste products.

### **Capillary Vessel**

A microscopic vessel with a thin endothelial wall where blood exchanges oxygen, carbon dioxide, nutrients, fluid, and waste with surrounding tissue.

### **Capnocytophaga**

A biomedical term referring to capnocytophaga; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Capnocytophaga Gingivalis**

A biomedical term referring to capnocytophaga gingivalis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Capnocytophaga Ochracea**

A biomedical term referring to capnocytophaga ochracea; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Capnocytophaga Sputigena**

A biomedical term referring to capnocytophaga sputigena; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Capreomycin**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by capreomycin. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Capromab Pendetide**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by capromab pendetide. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Capsid**

The protein shell surrounding the genome of a virus, protecting nucleic acid and helping determine at-



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tachment, entry, host range, and immune recognition.

### **Capsid Proteins**

Viral structural proteins that assemble around the genome to form the capsid and often participate in host-cell attachment, entry, and immune recognition.

### **Capsule**

A membrane, fibrous covering, or enclosed dosage form; in anatomy it may surround an organ or joint, while in pharmacology it contains medicine within a soluble shell.

### **Capsule Endoscope**

A swallowable camera-containing capsule that transmits images while passing through the gastrointestinal tract, especially useful for examining the small intestine.

### **Captopril**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by captopril. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Carbachol**

A cholinergic agonist that stimulates muscarinic receptors; ophthalmic carbachol can constrict the pupil and lower intraocular pressure during selected procedures.

### **Carbadox**

A quinoxaline antimicrobial growth-promoting drug formerly used in food-producing animals; safety concerns and carcinogenic potential have led to restrictions or bans.

### **Carbamate**

A chemical group found in pesticides and medicines; carbamate insecticides reversibly inhibit acetylcholinesterase and can cause a cholinergic toxidrome.

### **Carbamazepine**

A clinical condition or finding involving carbamazepine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Carbapenem**

A broad-spectrum beta-lactam antibiotic class that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and is reserved for serious infections, with resistance increasingly limiting use.

### **Carbaryl**

A carbamate insecticide that reversibly inhibits acetylcholinesterase; substantial exposure can cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, muscle weakness, and breathing problems.

### **Carbazilquinone**

An investigational quinone-containing anticancer compound studied for cytotoxic effects and bioreductive activity; it is not a routine clinical medicine.

### **Carbenicillin**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by carbenicillin. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Carbofuran**

A highly toxic carbamate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause rapid cholinergic poisoning after ingestion, inhalation, or skin exposure.

### **Carbogen**

A breathing mixture containing oxygen and carbon dioxide, used experimentally or in selected treatments to stimulate ventilation or modify tissue oxygenation.

### **Carbohydrate Metabolism**

Carbohydrate metabolism is used in relation to carbohydrate metabolism during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

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## Carbon

A biological or biochemical term referring to carbon. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

## Carbon Tetrachloride

A medicine or chemical compound identified by carbon tetrachloride. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## Carbonate

A medicine or chemical compound identified by carbonate. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## Carbophenothion

An organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase; poisoning produces excessive cholinergic activity and may cause respiratory failure.

## Carboplatin

A platinum chemotherapy drug that cross-links DNA and prevents replication; common dose-limiting toxicity is thrombocytopenia, with nausea, anemia, and hypersensitivity also possible.

## Carboprost

A prostaglandin F2-alpha analogue that contracts uterine muscle and is used for selected cases of postpartum hemorrhage or pregnancy termination; asthma is an important precaution.

## Carbosulfan

A carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause cholinergic poisoning after significant exposure.

## Carboxyl Group

A biological or biochemical term referring to carboxyl group. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

## Carboxylesterase

A clinical condition or finding involving carboxylesterase. Its defining features, causes, eval-

uation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Carboxylic Acid

An organic compound containing a carboxyl group, which can donate a proton and form salts or esters; many biologically important fatty acids and metabolic intermediates are carboxylic acids.

## Carboxy-Lyases

A clinical condition or finding involving carboxy-lyases. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Carboxypeptidase H

A clinical condition or finding involving carboxypeptidase h. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Carcinoembryonal Antigen

The tumor marker carcinoembryonic antigen, or CEA, a glycoprotein that may be elevated in colorectal and other cancers but is not specific enough for general screening.

## Carcinogen Testing

Carcinogen testing is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## Cardiac Care

Cardiac care refers to cardiac care, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Cardiac Catheter

Cardiac catheter refers to cardiac catheter, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Cardiac Fibroma

Cardiac fibroma refers to cardiac fibroma, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe

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a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Glycoside**

Cardiac glycoside refers to cardiac glycoside, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Hemangioma**

Cardiac hemangioma refers to cardiac hemangioma, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Myocyte**

Cardiac myocyte refers to cardiac myocyte, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Perforation**

Cardiac perforation refers to cardiac perforation, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Rhabdomyoma**

Cardiac rhabdomyoma refers to cardiac rhabdomyoma, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Sarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting cardiac sarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cardiac Ventriculography**

Cardiac ventriculography refers to cardiac ventriculography, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Volume**

Cardiac volume refers to cardiac volume, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardiac Wall**

Cardiac wall refers to cardiac wall, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body struc-

ture, process, or function.

### **Cardinal Body Part**

Cardinal body part refers to cardinal body part, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cardinal Cell Part**

A cellular process involving cardinal Cell Part; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cardiobacteriaceae**

Cardiobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Cardiobacterium**

Cardiobacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Cardiobacterium Hominis**

Cardiobacterium hominis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Cardiolipin**

A distinctive phospholipid concentrated in the inner mitochondrial membrane; antibodies to cardiolipin are among the laboratory markers of antiphospholipid syndrome.

### **Cardiologist**

Physician specializing in diagnosis and treatment of heart and cardiovascular diseases; trained in internal medicine and cardiology.

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### **Cardiotonic Agent**

A drug or substance that increases the force or efficiency of cardiac contraction, used selectively in heart failure or shock because benefits must be balanced against arrhythmia and other risks.

### **Cardiotoxin**

A clinical condition or finding involving cardiotoxin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cardiovascular Agents**

Medicines acting on the heart or blood vessels, including drugs for blood pressure, rhythm, angina, heart failure, thrombosis, and lipid disorders.

### **Cardiovascular Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving cardiovascular infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Cardiovascular Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving cardiovascular injury. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cardiovascular Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting cardiovascular neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cardiovascular Pharmacology**

The study of how medicines affect the heart, blood vessels, blood pressure, cardiac rhythm, coagulation, and lipid metabolism.

### **Cardiovascular Surgery**

Cardiovascular surgery is used in relation to cardiovascular surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Cardiovirus**

Cardiovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance

depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Carisoprodol**

A centrally acting skeletal-muscle relaxant metabolized partly to meprobamate and used short term for acute musculoskeletal pain; sedation, misuse, and dependence are important risks.

### **Carmine**

A red pigment derived from cochineal insects and used in foods, cosmetics, and medicines; it can rarely cause allergic reactions, including asthma or anaphylaxis.

### **Carmustine**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by carmustine. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Carney Triad**

A rare, usually nonhereditary association of gastric epithelioid leiomyosarcoma or gastrointestinal stromal tumor, pulmonary chondroma, and extra-adrenal paraganglioma.

### **Carnobacteriaceae**

Carnobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Carnosine**

A dipeptide of beta-alanine and histidine found in muscle and nervous tissue that buffers acidity and may limit protein glycation; many proposed supplement benefits remain unproven.

### **Carnosinemia**

A rare inherited disorder of carnosinase deficiency causing elevated carnosine in blood and urine, usually with developmental or neurologic abnormalities of variable severity.

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## **Carotene**

An orange-yellow plant pigment and provitamin-A carotenoid; beta-carotene can be converted to retinol, while excess dietary carotene may cause harmless yellow skin discoloration.

## **Carotenoid**

A family of lipid-soluble yellow, orange, or red pigments, including beta-carotene and lutein, that act in photosynthesis, antioxidant pathways, and sometimes vitamin-A production.

## **Carotid Body**

Carotid body refers to carotid body, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## **Carpal Bones**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as carpal bones. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

## **Carpal Joints**

The articulations among the eight carpal bones and between the carpus, radius, ulna, and metacarpals that permit coordinated wrist movement.

## **Carpometacarpal Joint**

A joint between a carpal bone and the base of a metacarpal; the thumb carpometacarpal joint is a highly mobile saddle joint commonly affected by osteoarthritis.

## **Carrageenan**

A sulfated polysaccharide extracted from red seaweed and used as a thickener or stabilizer in foods and pharmaceutical preparations; its inflammatory effects depend on form and exposure.

## **Carrier Excipient**

An inactive substance that carries or supports an active medicine in a formulation, helping control dose, stability, absorption, appearance, or delivery.

## **Carry-Over Effect**

Persistence of an intervention's effect into a later treatment period or measurement, potentially confounding a crossover study or subsequent clinical assessment.

## **Carteolol**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by carteolol. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## **Cartilage Disease**

A disorder damaging cartilage, the resilient connective tissue covering joints or supporting structures, causing pain, stiffness, deformity, impaired growth, or loss of smooth movement.

## **Carubicin**

A medicine or investigational pharmacologic compound; its mechanism, indication, dosing, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Carvedilol Phosphate**

A medicine or investigational pharmacologic compound; its mechanism, indication, dosing, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Carzelesin**

A medicine or investigational pharmacologic compound; its mechanism, indication, dosing, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Casanthranol**

A clinical condition or finding involving casanthranol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Case Study**

Case study is used in relation to case study during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

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### Case-Control Studies

A clinical condition or finding involving case-control studies. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Casein

A chemical, nutrient, pigment, or material whose physiologic or toxicologic effects depend on dose, route of exposure, metabolism, and tissue distribution.

### Casein Kinase

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### Caspase

A biological or biochemical term referring to caspase. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### Caspase Activation

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### Caspase Inhibitor

A biological or biochemical term referring to caspase inhibitor. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### Caspofungin

Caspofungin is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### Caspofungin Acetate

Caspofungin acetate is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### Castor Oil

A chemical, nutrient, pigment, or material whose physiologic or toxicologic effects depend on dose, route of exposure, metabolism, and tissue distribution.

### Castration

A clinical condition or finding involving castration. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Catalase

A biological or biochemical term referring to catalase. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### Cataract Surgery

Cataract surgery is used in relation to cataract surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### Catechin

A chemical, nutrient, pigment, or material whose physiologic or toxicologic effects depend on dose, route of exposure, metabolism, and tissue distribution.

### Catechol

A clinical condition or finding involving catechol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Catecholamine

A biological or biochemical term referring to catecholamine. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### Catenin

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### Cathepsin

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, pro-



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tein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsin D**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsin H**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsin K**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsin L**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsin Z**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cathepsins B**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Catheterization**

A medical procedure involving catheterization. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Cathexis**

A clinical condition or finding involving cathexis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Caudal Dysplasia**

A disorder, malformation, or clinical finding involving the body structure or process named by the term; diagnosis uses its characteristic pattern, history, examination, and appropriate testing.

### **Caudal Vein**

An anatomic structure or region related to caudal Vein; its location and function determine its normal relationships and clinical significance.

### **Caudate Nucleus**

An anatomic structure or region related to caudate Nucleus; its location and function determine its normal relationships and clinical significance.

### **Caulobacter**

Caulobacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Caulobacteraceae**

Caulobacteraceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Cautery Device**

An anatomic structure or region related to cautery Device; its location and function determine its normal relationships and clinical significance.

### **Caveola**

An anatomic structure or region related to caveola; its location and function determine its normal relationships and clinical significance.

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### **Caveolins**

A protein or enzyme involved in cell signaling, protein processing, or tissue organization; its biologic role depends on where it is expressed and what substrates or partners it encounters.

### **Cd Antigens**

A biological or biochemical term referring to cd antigens. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **CEA Assay**

CEA assay is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Cebocephaly**

A medicine or investigational pharmacologic compound; its mechanism, indication, dosing, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Cecal Hemorrhage**

A disorder, malformation, or clinical finding involving the body structure or process named by the term; diagnosis uses its characteristic pattern, history, examination, and appropriate testing.

### **Cecal Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving cecal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Cecal Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting cecal neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cedecea**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with cedecea. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Cedecea Davisae**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with cedecea davisae. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Cedecea Lapagei**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with cedecea lapagei. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Cedecea Neteri**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with cedecea neteri. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Cediranib Maleate**

A clinical condition or finding involving cediranib maleate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cefaclor**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefaclor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cefadroxil**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefadroxil. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cefamandole**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefamandole. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cefatrizine**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefatrizine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cefazolin**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefazolin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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**Cefdinir**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefdinir. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefepime**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefepime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefixime**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefixime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefmenoxime**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefmenoxime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefmetazole**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cefmetazole. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

**Cefonicid**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefonicid. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefoperazone**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefoperazone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefotaxime**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefotaxime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefotetan**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefotetan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefotiam**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefotiam. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefoxitin**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefoxitin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefsulodin**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefsulodin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Ceftazidime**

A clinical condition or finding involving ceftazidime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Ceftibuten**

A clinical condition or finding involving ceftibuten. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Ceftizoxime**

A clinical condition or finding involving ceftizoxime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Ceftriaxone**

A clinical condition or finding involving ceftriaxone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Cefuroxime**

A clinical condition or finding involving cefuroxime. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Celecoxib**

A medicine or investigational pharmacologic compound; its mechanism, indication, dosing, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

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### **Cell Adhesion**

The binding of cells to one another or to the extracellular matrix, mediated by adhesion molecules and important for tissue structure, signaling, and cell migration.

### **Cell Aggregation**

A cellular process involving cell Aggregation; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Body**

A cellular process involving cell Body; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Count**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cell count. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cell Culture**

Cell culture is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Cell Cycle**

The ordered series of cellular phases through which a cell grows, duplicates its DNA, and divides.

### **Cell Death**

The regulated elimination of cells through programmed cellular pathways that help maintain tissue balance and remove damaged cells.

### **Cell Dedifferentiation**

A cellular process involving cell Dedifferentiation; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Density**

A cellular process involving cell Density; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways

involved.

### **Cell Differentiation**

A cellular process involving cell Differentiation; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Division**

A cellular process involving cell Division; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Fusion**

A cellular process involving cell Fusion; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Growth**

A cellular process involving cell Growth; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Maturation**

A cellular process involving cell Maturation; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Migration**

A cellular process involving cell Migration; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Motility**

A cellular process involving cell Motility; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Movement**

A cellular process involving cell Movement; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Nucleus**

A cellular process involving cell Nucleus; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways

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involved.

### **Cell Pellet**

A cellular process involving cell Pellet; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Physiology**

A cellular process involving cell Physiology; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Polarity**

A cellular process involving cell Polarity; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Proliferation**

A cellular process involving cell Proliferation; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Secretion**

A cellular process involving cell Secretion; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Sorting**

A cellular process involving cell Sorting; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Structure**

A cellular process involving cell Structure; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Surface**

A cellular process involving cell Surface; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell Survival**

A cellular process involving cell Survival; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways

involved.

### **Cell Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to cell therapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Cell Transplantation**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to cell transplantation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Cell Wall**

A cellular process involving cell Wall; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell-Cell Junction**

A cellular process involving cell-Cell Junction; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell-Cell Signaling**

A cellular process involving cell-Cell Signaling; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell-Free System**

A cellular process involving cell-Free System; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cell-Matrix Junction**

A cellular process involving cell-Matrix Junction; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellular**

A cellular process involving cellular; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

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### **Cellular Immunity**

A cellular process involving cellular Immunity; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellular Metabolic Process**

A cellular process involving cellular Metabolic Process; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellular Respiration**

A cellular process involving cellular Respiration; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellular Vesicle**

A cellular process involving cellular Vesicle; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellulomonas**

A cellular process involving cellulomonas; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellulomonas Hominis**

A cellular process involving cellulomonas Hominis; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellulose**

A chemical, nutrient, pigment, or material whose physiologic or toxicologic effects depend on dose, route of exposure, metabolism, and tissue distribution.

### **Cellulosimicrobium**

A cellular process involving cellulosimicrobium; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Cellulosome**

A cellular process involving cellulosome; its effects depend on the cells, tissues, and biologic pathways involved.

### **Celosomy**

A clinical condition or finding involving celosomy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cementoma**

A clinical condition or finding involving cementoma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Centigram**

A metric unit of mass equal to one hundredth of a gram, or 10 milligrams, used for small quantities of medicines or specimens.

### **Centimeter**

Centimeter is used in relation to centimeter during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Centipoise**

A unit of dynamic viscosity equal to one millipascal-second, used to describe the flow resistance of blood, fluids, medicines, and other materials.

### **Central Apnea**

A pause in breathing caused by absent or reduced respiratory effort from impaired brainstem signaling, rather than upper-airway obstruction.

### **Centrifugation**

Spinning a specimen at high speed to separate components by density, such as cells from plasma or precipitated material from a liquid.

### **Centriole**

A cylindrical microtubule structure in the centrosome that helps organize the mitotic spindle and, in some cells, forms the basal body of a cilium or flagellum.

### **Centromere**

The constricted chromosome region where sister chromatids remain attached and the kinetochore forms for accurate chromosome segregation during



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cell division.

### **Centrosome**

The main microtubule-organizing center of an animal cell, containing a pair of centrioles and coordinating the spindle during mitosis.

### **Cephacetrile**

An older first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis; it is not commonly used in current practice.

### **Cephalexin**

An oral first-generation cephalosporin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats selected skin, respiratory, urinary, and other susceptible infections.

### **Cephalometry**

Measurement of the skull and facial structures, usually on standardized radiographs, used in orthodontic planning and assessment of craniofacial growth.

### **Cephaloridine**

An older injectable first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic whose use declined because of nephrotoxicity and the availability of safer alternatives.

### **Cephalothin**

An older injectable first-generation cephalosporin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and was used for susceptible serious infections.

### **Cephapirin**

A first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic formerly used for susceptible bacterial infections; current availability and indications vary by country.

### **Cephradine**

A first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic related to cephalexin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats selected susceptible infections.

### **Cerebellar Cortex**

The folded outer layer of the cerebellum containing

Purkinje and granular neurons that coordinates balance, posture, timing, and precision of movement.

### **Cerebellar Disease**

A disorder of the cerebellum causing impaired coordination, gait ataxia, dysmetria, tremor, abnormal eye movements, or speech changes.

### **Cerebellar Dysmetria**

Inability to control the range and force of a voluntary movement accurately, producing overshooting or undershooting from cerebellar dysfunction.

### **Cerebellar Hemangioblastoma**

A neoplastic process affecting cerebellar hemangioblastoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cerebellar Hypoplasia**

Underdevelopment of the cerebellum, usually beginning before birth, that may cause poor coordination, abnormal eye movements, seizures, and developmental impairment.

### **Cerebellar Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting cerebellar neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cerebellar Nuclei**

Deep clusters of cerebellar neurons that receive processed signals from the cerebellar cortex and send coordinated motor output to the brainstem and thalamus.

### **Cerebellar Vermis**

The midline portion of the cerebellum that helps control trunk posture, gait, balance, and coordination of eye and head movements.

### **Cerebral Aqueduct**

Cerebral aqueduct refers to cerebral aqueduct, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

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### **Cerebral Artery**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cerebral artery. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cerebral Atrophy**

Cerebral atrophy refers to cerebral atrophy, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Calcification**

Cerebral calcification refers to cerebral calcification, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Crus**

Cerebral crus refers to cerebral crus, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Hemisphere**

Cerebral hemisphere refers to cerebral hemisphere, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Ischemia**

Cerebral ischemia refers to cerebral ischemia, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Malaria**

Cerebral malaria refers to cerebral malaria, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Ventricle**

Cerebral ventricle refers to cerebral ventricle, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Ventriculography**

Cerebral ventriculography refers to cerebral ventriculography, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebral Ventriculomegaly**

Cerebral ventriculomegaly refers to cerebral ventriculomegaly, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Cerebrosides**

Glycosphingolipids composed of ceramide plus a single sugar, abundant in myelin and nervous tissue and involved in membrane structure.

### **Cerebrovascular Disorder**

A disorder of brain blood vessels or cerebral blood flow, including ischemia, hemorrhage, aneurysm, malformation, and venous thrombosis.

### **Cerium**

A rare-earth metal whose compounds have industrial and experimental medical uses; exposure to some forms can irritate tissues or cause toxicity.

### **Certification**

A formal process confirming that a person, service, laboratory, or facility meets specified training, quality, safety, or professional standards.

### **Certolizumab Pegol**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by certolizumab pegol. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Ceruminous Adenocarcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting ceruminous adenocarcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cervical**

Relating either to the neck portion of the spine or to the cervix of the uterus; the intended meaning is determined by the surrounding anatomic context.

### **Cervical Arthritis**

Degenerative or inflammatory disease of the neck joints that can cause neck pain, stiffness, reduced motion, and sometimes nerve or spinal-cord com-

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pression.

### **Cervical Atlas**

The first cervical vertebra, C1, a ring-shaped bone that supports the skull and rotates around the second cervical vertebra.

### **Cervical Change**

A change in the uterine cervix or cervical spine, depending on context; clinical significance is determined by the specific structural, inflammatory, or pregnancy-related finding.

### **Cervical Dislocation**

Abnormal displacement of one cervical vertebra relative to another, usually from trauma, that can destabilize the neck and injure the spinal cord.

### **Cervical Endometriosis**

Endometrial-like tissue in or on the cervix that may cause bleeding after sex, pelvic pain, or an abnormal cervical lesion.

### **Cervical Ganglion**

A cluster of nerve-cell bodies in the sympathetic chain of the neck that relays autonomic signals to the head, neck, and upper chest.

### **Cervical Insufficiency**

Painless shortening or opening of the cervix during pregnancy before term, increasing risk of second-trimester loss or spontaneous preterm birth.

### **Cervical Lymphadenopathy**

Enlarged lymph nodes in the neck, commonly caused by infection but sometimes reflecting malignancy, autoimmune disease, or other systemic illness.

### **Cervix Carcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting cervix carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cervix Disease**

A disorder of the lower uterine cervix, ranging from

infection and benign polyps to precancer, cancer, scarring, or pregnancy-related change.

### **Cervix Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting cervix neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Cesium**

A chemical element whose radioactive isotope cesium-137 can cause serious external or internal radiation injury after contamination or exposure.

### **Cestoda**

The tapeworm class of flatworms; human infection follows ingestion of eggs or larval tissue and can cause intestinal disease or tissue cysts.

### **Cetirizine**

A second-generation H1 antihistamine used for allergic rhinitis and urticaria; it is less sedating than older antihistamines but can still cause drowsiness.

### **Cetoleic Acid**

A long-chain monounsaturated fatty acid found mainly in marine oils and studied for effects on lipid metabolism and cellular membranes.

### **Cetrorelix**

A gonadotropin-releasing hormone antagonist used in controlled ovarian stimulation to prevent a premature luteinizing-hormone surge.

### **Cetuximab**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cetuximab. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Cevimeline**

A muscarinic receptor agonist used to stimulate salivary secretion and relieve dry mouth, especially in selected patients with Sjögren syndrome.

### **Cevimeline Hydrochloride**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by ce-

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vimeline hydrochloride. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Chaetomium**

A clinical condition or finding involving chaetomium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chagas Cardiomyopathy**

Chronic heart disease caused by *Trypanosoma cruzi* infection, with conduction defects, arrhythmias, ventricular dilation, heart failure, or thromboembolism.

### **Challenge Agent**

A substance, organism, allergen, or physiologic stimulus deliberately administered in a controlled test to provoke and measure a response.

### **Chamomile Extract**

An extract of chamomile flowers used in traditional and complementary products; allergic reactions and medicine interactions are possible, while evidence varies by indication.

### **Chaplain**

A trained spiritual-care professional who supports patients and families with religious, existential, emotional, or ethical concerns in healthcare settings.

### **Cheek**

The facial region forming the side wall of the mouth, containing skin, muscle, fat, salivary structures, nerves, and blood vessels.

### **Cheek Pouch**

A distensible pocket inside the cheek found in some rodents and other animals, used to temporarily store and transport food.

### **Cheilodysplasia**

Pain of the lips, which may result from inflammation, infection, trauma, allergy, dryness, nerve pain, or another oral or dermatologic disorder.

### **Cheilognathopalatoschisis**

A congenital cleft involving the lip, jaw, and palate, caused by incomplete fusion of facial processes during embryonic development.

### **Cheilognathoschisis**

A congenital cleft of the lip and alveolar part of the upper jaw, with or without associated palatal involvement.

### **Cheirromegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of one or both hands, classically associated with excess growth hormone but also possible with local overgrowth or other disorders.

### **Chelating Agent**

A compound that binds a metal ion through multiple chemical sites, allowing the metal to be measured, mobilized, or removed in selected toxic exposures.

### **Chemexfoliation**

Application of a chemical solution to remove controlled layers of skin, improving selected scars, pigmentation, wrinkles, or superficial lesions.

### **Chemical**

A substance defined by its molecular composition and properties; medical effects depend on dose, route, exposure duration, metabolism, and biological target.

### **Chemical Ablation**

Destruction of unwanted tissue by injecting or applying a chemical irritant or sclerosant, used in selected lesions, vessels, cysts, or other conditions.

### **Chemical Burn**

Tissue injury caused by a corrosive acid, alkali, solvent, or other chemical, which may continue to penetrate until the substance is removed and neutralized appropriately.

### **Chemical Carcinogenesis**

Development of cancer after exposure to chemicals

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that cause DNA damage, abnormal cell signaling, chronic tissue injury, or altered gene regulation.

### **Chemical Cleavage**

Breaking a chemical bond with a reagent, used in laboratory analysis, molecular biology, synthesis, or controlled degradation of a larger molecule.

### **Chemical Cofactor**

A nonprotein chemical helper required for an enzyme or biologic reaction, such as a metal ion, vitamin-derived coenzyme, or other small molecule.

### **Chemical Fractionation**

Separation of a mixture into fractions according to chemical or physical properties such as solubility, charge, size, or binding affinity.

### **Chemical Impurity**

An unintended chemical present in a medicine, specimen, or material, potentially affecting safety, stability, measurement accuracy, or biologic activity.

### **Chemistry**

The study of substances, their composition, properties, reactions, and transformations, forming the basis of biochemistry, pharmacology, toxicology, and laboratory medicine.

### **Chemokine Receptor**

A cell-surface receptor that binds chemokines and directs immune-cell movement; some also serve as entry cofactors for viruses such as HIV.

### **Chemoreceptor Cell**

A sensory cell that detects chemical changes such as oxygen, carbon dioxide, pH, taste molecules, or odorants and converts them into neural or physiologic signals.

### **Chemosensitivity Assay**

Chemosensitivity assay is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the

method and reference range.

### **Chemosensitization**

Increasing a tumor's or pathogen's susceptibility to a treatment by combining it with another agent that improves drug delivery, blocks resistance, or enhances cellular damage.

### **Chemotactic Factors**

Chemical signals that attract or repel cells, especially leukocytes, by creating directional concentration gradients during inflammation, infection, development, or repair.

### **Chemotherapy Regimen**

Chemotherapy regimen is used in relation to chemotherapy regimen during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Chest Tightness**

A sensation of pressure, constriction, or heaviness in the chest that may arise from heart, lung, gastrointestinal, musculoskeletal, or anxiety-related causes.

### **Chick Embryo**

The developing chicken embryo, widely used as an experimental model for embryology, organ development, virology, toxicology, and tissue growth.

### **Child Behavior**

Child behavior is used in relation to child behavior during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Child Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to child care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Child Development**

Progressive physical, cognitive, language, emotional, and social changes from infancy through adolescence, assessed against developmental milestones and individual variation.

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## **Child Psychiatry**

The medical specialty concerned with assessment and treatment of emotional, behavioral, developmental, and psychiatric disorders in children and adolescents.

## **Child Psychology**

The study of children's cognitive, emotional, social, and behavioral development and the effects of relationships, learning, biology, and environment.

## **Child Welfare**

Services and policies intended to protect children from abuse or neglect and support safety, health, stable caregiving, development, and family well-being.

## **Childhood Angiosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood angiosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Ependymoma**

A tumor arising from ependymal cells lining the brain ventricles or spinal canal in children; symptoms depend on location and obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid flow.

## **Childhood Fibrosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood fibrosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Ganglioglioma**

A usually slow-growing mixed neuronal and glial brain tumor in children or young adults, often presenting with long-standing focal seizures.

## **Childhood Leiomyosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood leiomyosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Leukemia**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood leukemia;

diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Liposarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood liposarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Osteosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood osteosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Childhood Rhabdomyosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting childhood rhabdomyosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## **Children**

Humans in the developmental period between infancy and adolescence; medical assessment must account for age-specific anatomy, physiology, growth, communication, and consent.

## **Chilomastix Mesnili**

A nonpathogenic intestinal flagellate protozoan that may be found in stool and indicates fecal exposure but usually does not require treatment.

## **Chimera**

An organism or tissue containing genetically distinct cell populations derived from different zygotes or embryos, or a laboratory construct combining genetic material from different sources.

## **Chin**

The lower facial prominence formed mainly by the mandible and overlying soft tissue, contributing to facial contour, speech, chewing, and airway anatomy.

## **Chironomidae**

The nonbiting midge family of insects; their larvae and body parts can act as environmental allergens



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and rarely trigger respiratory or skin reactions.

### **Chiropractic**

A healthcare practice centered mainly on manual treatment of musculoskeletal disorders, especially spinal manipulation; benefits and risks vary by condition and technique.

### **Chitin**

A biological or biochemical term referring to chitin. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Chitosan**

A biodegradable polysaccharide derived from chitin, studied and used in wound dressings, drug delivery, hemostatic materials, and some nutritional products.

### **Chlamydiaceae**

Chlamydiaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Chlamydomona**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydomona. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chlamydomphila**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydomphila. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chlamydomphila Pneumoniae**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydomphila pneumoniae. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chlamydomphila Psittaci**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydomphila psittaci. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chloral Hydrate**

A clinical condition or finding involving chloral hydrate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorambucil**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by chlorambucil. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Chlordane**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlordane. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlordecone**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlordecone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlordiazepoxide**

Chlordiazepoxide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in chlordiazepoxide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Chlorethoxyfos**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorethoxyfos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorfenvinphos**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorfenvinphos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorhexidine**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorhexidine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chloride Channel**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by chloride channel. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

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### Chloride Ion

The negatively charged form of chlorine and a major extracellular electrolyte that helps maintain fluid balance, osmotic pressure, acid–base status, and electrical neutrality.

### Chlorine

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlormadinone Acetate

A clinical condition or finding involving chlormadinone acetate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlormerodrin

A clinical condition or finding involving chlormerodrin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlorodeoxyadenosine

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorodeoxyadenosine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloroform

A clinical condition or finding involving chloroform. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlorogenic Acid

Chlorogenic acid is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in chlorogenic acid and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### Chlorophyll

A biological or biochemical term referring to chlorophyll. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### Chlorophyta

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorophyta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloropicrin

A clinical condition or finding involving chloropicrin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloroplast

A clinical condition or finding involving chloroplast. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloroplast DNA

A clinical condition or finding involving chloroplast dna. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloroprene

A clinical condition or finding involving chloroprene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chloroquine

A clinical condition or finding involving chloroquine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlorothiazide

A medicine or chemical compound identified by chlorothiazide. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### Chlorotoxin

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorotoxin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Chlorotrianisene

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorotrianisene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Chlorpheniramine**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorpheniramine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorphentermine**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorphentermine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorpromazine**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorpromazine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorpropamide**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorpropamide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorpyrifos**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorpyrifos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorthalidone**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorthalidone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlorzoxazone**

A clinical condition or finding involving chlorzoxazone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **CHO Cell**

A Chinese hamster ovary cell line widely used to produce recombinant proteins, antibodies, vaccines, and other biologic medicines.

### **Choice Behavior**

Choice behavior is used in relation to choice behavior during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Choke**

Airway blockage by food or another object that prevents normal airflow and can rapidly cause inability to speak, cyanosis, loss of consciousness, or death.

### **Cholate**

The ionized form of cholic acid, a primary bile acid that helps emulsify dietary fat and is conjugated and secreted by the liver.

### **Cholecalciferol**

Vitamin D3, produced in skin by ultraviolet light and obtained from food or supplements, then converted to active metabolites that regulate calcium and phosphate.

### **Cold Hands**

Hands that feel unusually cold, which may result from environmental exposure, reduced blood flow, Raynaud phenomenon, anemia, thyroid disease, or other medical conditions.

### **Coughing Up Blood**

Expectoration of blood or blood-streaked sputum from the lower respiratory tract, called hemoptysis; heavy bleeding or breathing difficulty is an emergency.

### **Carcinoid Tumors**

Slow-growing neuroendocrine tumors that can release hormones and arise in organs such as the digestive tract or lungs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Carcinoid Tumors

### **Childhood Apraxia Of Speech**

A speech-sound disorder in which a child has difficulty planning and coordinating the movements needed for clear speech.

#### **Synonyms:**

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### **Cataracts**

Clouding of the eye's natural lens that causes blurred vision, glare, faded colors, or difficulty see-

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ing at night.

### **Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia (CDH)**

A birth defect in which an opening in the diaphragm allows abdominal organs to move into the chest and interfere with lung development.

### **Cellulite**

Cellulite refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Central Nervous System (CNS)**

#### **Lymphoma**

A lymphoma involving the brain, spinal cord, cerebrospinal fluid, or eye that can cause neurologic or visual symptoms.

### **CSF Leak (Cerebrospinal Fluid Leak)**

Escape of cerebrospinal fluid through a tear in the membranes surrounding the brain or spinal cord, often causing positional headache.

#### **Synonyms:**

Spinal Fluid Leak

### **Chilblains**

Painful, itchy, swollen skin lesions caused by an abnormal response to cold and damp conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pernio

### **Chronic Exertional Compartment Syndrome**

Exercise-related increased pressure within a muscle compartment that causes predictable pain, tightness, or neurologic symptoms during activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chronic Compartment Syndrome

### **Cleft Lip And Cleft Palate**

Birth defects in which the lip, roof of the mouth, or both fail to fuse completely during development.

### **Common Warts**

Small, rough skin growths caused by infection with human papillomavirus, commonly affecting the hands and fingers.

#### **Synonyms:**

Warts, Common Warts (Common Warts)

### **Cyclosporiasis (Cyclospora)**

An intestinal infection caused by Cyclospora parasites, typically producing prolonged watery diarrhea, cramps, nausea, and fatigue.

### **Cyclothymia (Cyclothymic Disorder)**

A chronic mood disorder involving repeated periods of hypomanic and depressive symptoms that do not meet criteria for full episodes.

### **Cytomegalovirus (CMV) Infection**

Cytomegalovirus infection is caused by a herpesvirus that is often mild in healthy people but can cause congenital disease or severe organ infection in immunocompromised patients.

### **CA-125 Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate ca-125. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Caffeine Overdose**

Caffeine overdose can cause agitation, tremor, vomiting, rapid heartbeat, abnormal rhythm, seizures, and dangerous metabolic disturbances.

### **Caladium Plant Poisoning**

Poisoning caused by calcium oxalate crystals in the plant. Chewing may cause immediate burning and swelling of the mouth and throat; airway symptoms require emergency care.

### **Calcitonin Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate calcitonin. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

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### **Calcium - Ionized**

Ionized calcium is the biologically active, unbound portion of blood calcium involved in muscle contraction, nerve signaling, and clotting.

### **Calcium - Urine**

Urine calcium measures calcium excretion and helps evaluate kidney stones, parathyroid disorders, bone disease, and some metabolic conditions.

### **Calcium And Bones**

Calcium and bones refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Calcium Carbonate Overdose**

Overdose of calcium carbonate that may cause gastrointestinal symptoms, hypercalcemia, alkalosis, kidney injury, or kidney stones.

### **Calcium Carbonate With Magnesium Overdose**

Overdose of calcium and magnesium salts that may cause nausea, constipation, weakness, altered mental status, hypercalcemia, or kidney injury.

### **Calcium Hydroxide Poisoning**

Exposure to a caustic alkali that can burn the mouth, esophagus, skin, or eyes. Airway and gastrointestinal injury require urgent assessment.

### **Calla Lily Poisoning**

Poisoning caused by calcium oxalate crystals in the plant. Chewing may cause immediate burning and swelling of the mouth and throat; airway symptoms require emergency care.

### **Caloric Stimulation**

A vestibular test that introduces warm or cool air or water into the ear canal to create convection in the semicircular canal and assess each vestibular nerve.

### **Calorie Count - Alcoholic Beverages**

A clinical condition or finding involving calorie count - alcoholic beverages. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Calorie Count - Fast Food**

A clinical condition or finding involving calorie count - fast food. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Calorie Count - Sodas And Energy Drinks**

A clinical condition or finding involving calorie count - sodas and energy drinks. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Campho-Phenique Overdose**

Overdose of a topical product containing camphor and other ingredients. Toxicity may include gastrointestinal or neurologic symptoms, including seizures.

### **Camphor Overdose**

Overdose of camphor that can cause nausea, agitation, seizures, coma, and respiratory depression. Seizures may occur rapidly and require emergency treatment.

### **Campylobacter Serology Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate campylobacter serology. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Can You Boost Your Metabolism?**

A health question about increasing energy expenditure; activity, muscle mass, sleep, diet, medicines, and endocrine disease influence metabolism, while quick “boosts” are usually modest.

### **Can'T Sleep? Try These Tips**

A patient-care topic concerning can't sleep? try these tips. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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## **Cancer - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning cancer - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Cancer And Lymph Nodes**

A neoplastic condition involving cancer And Lymph Nodes; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Cancer Prevention: Take Charge Of Your Lifestyle**

A patient-care topic concerning cancer prevention: take charge of your lifestyle. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Cancer Treatment - Dealing With Pain**

A neoplastic condition involving cancer Treatment - Dealing With Pain; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Cancer Treatment - Early Menopause**

A neoplastic condition involving cancer Treatment - Early Menopause; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Cancer Treatment - Preventing Infection**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with cancer treatment - preventing infection. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

## **Cancer Treatment: Dealing With Hot Flashes And Night Sweats**

A neoplastic condition involving cancer Treatment: Dealing With Hot Flashes And Night Sweats; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Cancer Treatment: Fertility And Sexual Side Effects In Women**

A patient-care topic concerning cancer treatment: fertility and sexual side effects in women. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Cancer Treatments**

A neoplastic condition involving cancer Treatments; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Candida Auris Infection**

Candida auris infection is an invasive or colonizing yeast infection notable for healthcare transmission and frequent resistance to antifungal medicines.

## **Candida Infection Of The Skin**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with candida infection of the skin. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

## **Candles Poisoning**

Poisoning after ingestion of candle material or exposure to candle products. Effects are usually gastrointestinal, but product ingredients and aspiration risk determine severity.

## **Capillary Nail Refill Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate capillary nail refill. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Capillary Sample**

A small blood specimen obtained by puncturing the skin, usually a finger or heel, for bedside glucose, hemoglobin, newborn screening, or other point-of-care tests.

## **Carbohydrates**

A clinical condition or finding involving carbohydrates. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Carbolic Acid Poisoning**

Exposure to phenol, a corrosive and systemically toxic chemical that can cause burns, altered consciousness, metabolic acidosis, and organ injury.

## **Cardiac Ablation Procedures**

A medical procedure involving cardiac ablation pro-



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cedures. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Cardiac Catheterization - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving cardiac catheterization - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Cardiac Event Monitors**

A clinical condition or finding involving cardiac event monitors. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cardiac Glycoside Overdose**

Overdose of a cardiac glycoside, such as digoxin, that may cause nausea, vomiting, visual changes, confusion, bradyarrhythmias, tachyarrhythmias, and hyperkalemia.

### **Cardiac Intravascular Ultrasound**

An ultrasound examination that uses sound waves to produce images of the specified body region and assess its structure.

### **Caregiving - Medication Management**

A patient-care topic concerning caregiving - medication management. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Caregiving - Resources - Older Adults**

A patient-care topic concerning caregiving - resources - older adults. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Caregiving - Taking Your Loved One To The Doctor**

A patient-care topic concerning caregiving - taking your loved one to the doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Caring For Muscle Spasticity Or Spasms**

Caring for muscle spasticity or spasms refers to a

defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Carotid Artery Stenosis - Self-Care**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as carotid artery stenosis - self-care. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Carotid Artery Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving carotid artery surgery - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Carotid Artery Surgery - Open**

A medical procedure involving carotid artery surgery - open. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Carpal Tunnel Biopsy**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

### **Carpal Tunnel Release**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as carpal tunnel release. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Castor Oil Overdose**

Excessive ingestion of castor oil that may cause abdominal cramping, nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea with fluid and electrolyte loss.

### **Cataract - Adult**

An adult cataract is clouding of the eye lens that progressively reduces visual acuity, contrast, or glare tolerance; definitive treatment is lens-replacement surgery when function is impaired.

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## Cataract Removal

A medical procedure involving cataract removal. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

## Cataracts - What To Ask Your Doctor

A clinical condition or finding involving cataracts - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Catecholamine Blood Test

A diagnostic test used to evaluate catecholamine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## Catecholamines - Urine

A biological or biochemical term referring to catecholamines - urine. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

## Caterpillars

The larval stage of butterflies and moths; contact with some species' hairs or spines can cause painful dermatitis, eye injury, or allergic reactions.

## Catheter-Related UTI

Catheter-related UTI is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

## Caulking Compound Poisoning

Exposure to caulking compounds that may irritate the skin, eyes, or airways; ingestion can cause gastrointestinal symptoms and aspiration risk depending on the product.

## Causes And Risks For Obesity In Children

Childhood obesity reflects interactions among inherited susceptibility, food and activity environments, sleep, medicines, endocrine disease, and social factors; risk is assessed using age- and sex-specific

growth charts.

## CBC Blood Test

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cbc. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## CEA Blood Test

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cea. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## Cedar Leaf Oil Poisoning

Ingestion or inhalation of cedar leaf oil, which may irritate tissues and cause gastrointestinal or neurologic toxicity depending on the dose.

## Celiac Disease - Nutritional Considerations

A patient-care topic concerning celiac disease - nutritional considerations. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Celiac Disease - Resources

A patient-care topic concerning celiac disease - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Celiac Disease - Sprue

Celiac disease is an immune-mediated reaction to gluten that damages small-intestinal villi and can cause malabsorption, anemia, diarrhea, weight loss, or extraintestinal disease.

## Cell Phones And Cancer

Cell phones and cancer refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## Centipede

A many-legged arthropod whose bite can inject venom and cause local pain, swelling, and redness; severe allergic reactions are uncommon but possible.

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### **Central Line Infections - Hospitals**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with central line infections - hospitals. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Central Serous Choroidopathy**

Central serous chorioretinopathy is leakage beneath the retina causing localized fluid and blurred or distorted central vision, often resolving but sometimes recurring.

### **Central Venous Catheter - Dressing Change**

Central venous catheter - dressing change is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Central Venous Catheter - Flushing**

Central venous catheter - flushing is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Central Venous Catheters - Ports**

Central venous catheters - ports is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **Central Venous Line - Infants**

A catheter whose tip lies in a large central vein of an infant, used for irritant medicines, nutrition, fluids, blood sampling, or monitoring; infection and thrombosis are key risks.

### **Cerebral Palsy - Resources**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cerebral palsy - resources. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cerebrospinal Fluid (CSF) Collection**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as

cerebrospinal fluid (csf) collection. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cerebrospinal Fluid (CSF) Culture**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cerebrospinal fluid (csf). Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Certified Nurse-Midwife**

An advanced-practice nurse trained and credentialed to provide reproductive, pregnancy, birth, postpartum, and newborn care, including management of normal pregnancy and referral of complications.

### **Ceruloplasmin Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate ceruloplasmin. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cervical Cancer - Screening And Prevention**

A patient-care topic concerning cervical cancer - screening and prevention. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Cervical MRI Scan**

A magnetic resonance imaging study that produces detailed images of the specified body region using magnetic fields and radiofrequency energy.

### **Cervical Spine CT Scan**

A computed tomography study that produces cross-sectional X-ray images of the specified body region.

### **Cervix Cryosurgery**

A medical procedure involving cervix cryosurgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Chafing**

Skin irritation caused by repeated friction, moisture, heat, or tight clothing, producing redness, burning, tenderness, and sometimes erosions in opposing or

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rubbing areas.

### **Changes In The Newborn At Birth**

The newborn transition from placental support to independent breathing and circulation, including lung aeration, closure of fetal shunts, temperature control, and adaptation of glucose and feeding.

### **Changing Your Ostomy Pouch**

Replacing the pouching system attached around a colostomy or ileostomy, including gentle removal, skin cleansing and measurement, barrier fitting, leak prevention, and disposal.

### **Changing Your Sleep Habits**

Behavioral changes that support regular restorative sleep, including a consistent schedule, a suitable dark environment, limiting late stimulants and screens, and addressing persistent insomnia or sleep apnea.

### **Changing Your Urostomy Pouch**

Replacing the pouching system that collects urine from a urostomy, with attention to skin protection, a secure seal, drainage, hydration, and warning signs of infection or obstruction.

### **Chapped Hands**

Dry, cracked, inflamed skin of the hands caused by irritants, cold, low humidity, frequent washing, eczema, or allergy; fissures can become painful or infected.

### **Chapped Lips**

Dry, scaling, fissured lips caused by weather, licking, dehydration, irritants, medicines, or cheilitis; persistent lesions need assessment for infection or another disorder.

### **Charley Horse**

A sudden painful involuntary contraction or spasm of a muscle, commonly in the calf or thigh, often related to exertion, dehydration, nerve disease, or medicines.

### **Chemical Burn Or Reaction**

A clinical condition or finding involving chemical burn or reaction. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chemical Dependence - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning chemical dependence - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chemotherapy - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving chemotherapy - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chest CT**

A clinical condition or finding involving chest ct. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chest MRI**

A clinical condition or finding involving chest mri. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chest Radiation - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning chest radiation - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chicken Soup And Sickness**

A supportive-care topic concerning the use of warm fluids and nutrition during illness; chicken soup may ease hydration or congestion but does not replace diagnosis or treatment.

### **Chiggers**

Larval harvest mites whose bite causes intensely itchy grouped red papules or welts; symptoms result from skin irritation, not from the mite burrowing into human tissue.

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### **Child Neglect And Emotional Abuse**

A clinical condition or finding involving child neglect and emotional abuse. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Child Physical Abuse**

Intentional physical injury or harm inflicted on a child by a caregiver or another person, including hitting, burning, shaking, or fractures; suspected abuse requires immediate safeguarding assessment.

### **Child Safety Seats**

A patient-care topic concerning child safety seats. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Children And Grief**

The emotional and behavioral response of children to death or major loss, which varies by developmental stage and may include sadness, regression, anger, worry, or physical symptoms.

### **Children's Cancer Centers**

A neoplastic condition involving children's Cancer Centers; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Chin Augmentation**

A cosmetic procedure that increases chin projection with an implant, injectable filler, or bone surgery to change facial contour; risks include infection, asymmetry, nerve injury, and implant problems.

### **Chiropractic Care For Back Pain**

A patient-care topic concerning chiropractic care for back pain. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chiropractor Profession**

A clinical condition or finding involving chiropractor profession. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Chlamydia Infections In Women**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydia infections in women. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chlamydial Infections - Male**

A microorganism or infectious condition associated with chlamydial infections - male. Clinical effects depend on the organism, site of infection, and host factors.

### **Chlordiazepoxide Overdose**

Overdose of chlordiazepoxide, a benzodiazepine, that can cause drowsiness, impaired coordination, respiratory depression, and coma, especially with other sedatives.

### **Chloride - Urine Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate chloride - urine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Chloride In Diet**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by chloride in diet. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Chloride Test - Blood**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate chloride test - blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Chlorinated Lime Poisoning**

Exposure to chlorinated lime, a hypochlorite-containing corrosive that can injure the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Chlorine Poisoning**

Inhalation or contact exposure to chlorine gas, which irritates the eyes and airways and can cause cough, bronchospasm, chemical pneumonitis, or pulmonary edema.

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## **Chlorophyll Poisoning**

Ingestion of chlorophyll-containing products, which usually causes mild gastrointestinal effects; product ingredients and dose determine clinical risk.

## **Chlorpromazine Overdose**

Overdose of chlorpromazine that may cause sedation, hypotension, anticholinergic effects, seizures, cardiac conduction abnormalities, or neuroleptic malignant syndrome.

## **Choking - Adult Or Child Over 1 Year**

First aid for severe airway obstruction in a person older than one year, using back blows and abdominal thrusts when appropriate and CPR if the person becomes unresponsive.

## **Choking - Infant Under 1 Year**

First aid for severe airway obstruction in an infant, using alternating back slaps and chest thrusts and avoiding blind finger sweeps; unresponsiveness requires infant CPR.

## **Choking - Unconscious Adult Or Child Over 1 Year**

Resuscitation for an unresponsive person with suspected airway obstruction, combining emergency activation, airway inspection, CPR, and removal of a visible object without blind sweeping.

## **Cholesterol - Drug Treatment**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cholesterol - drug treatment. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## **Cholesterol - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cholesterol - what to ask your doctor. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## **Cholesterol And Lifestyle**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cholesterol and lifestyle. Its uses, effects, and risks

depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## **Cholesterol Testing And Results**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cholesterol testing and results. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Cholinesterase - Blood**

A blood test measuring acetylcholinesterase or butyrylcholinesterase activity, useful in selected pesticide exposures, inherited enzyme variants, and some liver-function assessments.

## **Choosing A Doctor And Hospital For Your Cancer Treatment**

A patient-care topic concerning choosing a doctor and hospital for your cancer treatment. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Choosing A Primary Care Provider**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to choosing a primary care provider; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Choosing A Skilled Nursing And Rehabilitation Facility**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to choosing a skilled nursing and rehabilitation facility; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Choosing Effective Patient Education Materials**

A clinical condition or finding involving choosing effective patient education materials. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Choosing The Right Health Care Provider For Pregnancy And Childbirth**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care



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topic related to choosing the right health care provider for pregnancy and childbirth; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Choroidal Dystrophies**

Inherited disorders causing progressive degeneration of the choroid, retinal pigment epithelium, and retina, leading to night blindness, visual-field loss, and eventual vision impairment.

### **Chromatography**

A laboratory separation method in which substances partition between a stationary phase and a moving phase, allowing identification or measurement of components in a mixture.

### **Chromium - Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate chromium -. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Chromium In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning chromium in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chronic Cholecystitis**

Chronic cholecystitis is repeated or persistent gallbladder inflammation, usually related to gallstones, causing episodic right-upper-abdominal pain or digestive symptoms.

### **Chronic Fatigue Syndrome - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning chronic fatigue syndrome - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (CLL)**

CLL is a usually slow-growing cancer of mature B lymphocytes that can cause lymph-node enlargement, low blood counts, infections, or no symptoms for years.

### **Chronic Motor Or Vocal Tic Disorder**

A clinical condition involving chronic Motor Or Vocal Tic Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Chronic Myelogenous Leukemia (CML)**

CML is a blood and bone-marrow cancer driven by the BCR-ABL1 fusion, causing excess myeloid cells and treated mainly with tyrosine-kinase inhibitors.

### **Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease - Adults - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning chronic obstructive pulmonary disease - adults - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD)**

Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease is persistent airflow limitation from airway and alveolar injury, commonly causing exertional breathlessness, cough, sputum, and exacerbations.

### **Chronic Pain - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning chronic pain - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Chronic Subdural Hematoma**

A collection of blood and breakdown products between the dura and arachnoid that develops over weeks, often after minor trauma in older adults, causing headache, confusion, weakness, or gait change.

### **Chronic Thyroiditis (Hashimoto Disease)**

A clinical condition involving chronic Thyroiditis (Hashimoto Disease); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Chylomicronemia Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving chylomicronemia Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and com-

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plications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Cirrhosis - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning cirrhosis - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Citric Acid Urine Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate citric acid urine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Clean Catch Urine Sample**

A midstream urine specimen collected after cleaning the genital area to reduce contamination and improve interpretation of urinalysis or culture.

### **Cleaning Supplies And Equipment**

Materials and devices used to remove soil and microorganisms from surfaces or equipment; selection and disinfection level depend on the item and infection risk.

### **Cleaning To Prevent The Spread Of Germs**

Cleaning and disinfection practices that remove or inactivate infectious organisms on hands, surfaces, equipment, and shared objects to reduce transmission.

### **Clear Liquid Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning clear liquid diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Cleft Lip And Palate Repair**

A medical procedure involving cleft lip and palate repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Cleft Lip And Palate Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving cleft lip and palate repair - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition

and the specific procedure.

### **Cleft Palate - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning cleft palate - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Cleidocranial Dysostosis**

Cleidocranial dysostosis is an inherited skeletal disorder with underdeveloped clavicles, delayed closure of skull sutures, short stature, and numerous unerupted teeth.

### **Closed Reduction Of A Fractured Bone**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as closed reduction of a fractured bone. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Closed Reduction Of A Fractured Bone - Aftercare**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as closed reduction of a fractured bone - aftercare. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Closed Suction Drain With Bulb**

A clinical condition or finding involving closed suction drain with bulb. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cloth Dye Poisoning**

Exposure to cloth dyes that may cause irritation, gastrointestinal symptoms, allergic reactions, or systemic toxicity depending on the chemical composition.

### **Cloudy Cornea**

Loss of corneal transparency from edema, scarring, infection, dystrophy, trauma, or deposits, potentially causing blurred vision, pain, photophobia, or glare.

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### **Clubbing Of The Fingers Or Toes**

Bulbous enlargement of fingertip or toe soft tissue with increased nail curvature caused by chronic changes in the nail bed; it can accompany lung, heart, gastrointestinal, or other disease.

### **Clubfoot Repair**

A medical procedure involving clubfoot repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **CMV - Gastroenteritis/Colitis**

Cytomegalovirus gastroenteritis or colitis is tissue-invasive CMV infection causing pain, diarrhea, bleeding, or ulcers, especially during immune suppression.

### **CMV Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cmv. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **CMV Pneumonia**

A clinical condition involving cMV Pneumonia; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **CMV Retinitis**

CMV retinitis is sight-threatening inflammation and infection of the retina, occurring mainly with severe immune suppression and requiring urgent antiviral treatment.

### **CO2 Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate co2. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cobalt Poisoning**

Toxic exposure to cobalt that may cause gastrointestinal, neurologic, thyroid, cardiac, or lung effects after significant or prolonged exposure.

### **Cocaine Intoxication**

Cocaine intoxication causing sympathetic stimulation, agitation, hyperthermia, seizures, hypertension, arrhythmias, myocardial ischemia, or stroke.

### **Cocaine Withdrawal**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by cocaine withdrawal. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Coccidioides Complement Fixation**

Coccidioides complement-fixation testing detects antibodies suggesting exposure or infection with Coccidioides, the fungus that causes coccidioidomycosis.

### **Coccidioides Precipitin Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate coccidioides precipitin. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Codeine Overdose**

Overdose of codeine, an opioid, that can cause respiratory depression, impaired consciousness, pinpoint pupils, and coma. Naloxone may be required in emergency care.

### **Cognitive Behavioral Therapy For Back Pain**

A clinical condition involving cognitive Behavioral Therapy For Back Pain; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Cold Medicines And Children**

Safety guidance for giving medicines to children with cold symptoms; many combination products provide little benefit in young children and can cause dosing errors or serious adverse effects.

### **Cold Wave Lotion Poisoning**

Exposure to cold-wave lotion, which may contain thioglycolates or other irritants and can cause burns, gastrointestinal symptoms, or respiratory irritation.

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### **Colds And Flu - Antibiotics**

An explanation that antibiotics treat susceptible bacterial infections, not uncomplicated viral colds or influenza; unnecessary use causes adverse effects and antimicrobial resistance.

### **Colds And The Flu - What To Ask Your Doctor - Adult**

A clinical condition or finding involving colds and the flu - what to ask your doctor - adult. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Colds And The Flu - What To Ask Your Doctor - Child**

A clinical condition or finding involving colds and the flu - what to ask your doctor - child. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Colic And Crying - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning colic and crying - self-care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Collagen Vascular Disease**

A clinical condition involving collagen Vascular Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Collapsed Lung (Pneumothorax)**

A clinical finding or condition involving collapsed Lung (Pneumothorax); evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Collateral Ligament (CL) Injury - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning collateral ligament (cl) injury - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **College Students And The Flu**

Influenza prevention and care for college students, emphasizing vaccination, hand and respiratory hy-

giene, staying home when ill, and prompt assessment for severe symptoms or high-risk conditions.

### **Colles Wrist Fracture - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning colles wrist fracture - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Coloboma Of The Iris**

A congenital keyhole- or notch-shaped defect in the iris caused by incomplete embryonic closure, sometimes associated with colobomas in the retina, optic nerve, or other organs.

### **Cologne Poisoning**

Ingestion of cologne containing alcohol and fragrances that may cause intoxication, hypoglycemia, respiratory depression, or gastrointestinal irritation.

### **Cologuard**

A stool-based colorectal-cancer screening test combining DNA-marker analysis with a fecal blood test; a positive result requires diagnostic colonoscopy.

### **Colon Cancer Screening**

A patient-care topic concerning colon cancer screening. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Colonoscopy Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning colonoscopy discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Color Vision Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate color vision. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Colorectal Cancer - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning colorectal cancer - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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## Colorectal Polyps

A clinical condition or finding involving colorectal polyps. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Colposcopy - Directed Biopsy

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

## Comedones

Plugs of sebum and keratin within hair follicles, appearing as open blackheads or closed whiteheads and representing a primary lesion of acne.

## Common Peroneal Nerve Dysfunction

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as common peroneal nerve dysfunction. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

## Common Symptoms During Pregnancy

Frequent pregnancy-related symptoms such as nausea, fatigue, breast tenderness, heartburn, constipation, and urinary frequency; severe, sudden, or unusual symptoms may signal complications.

## Communicating With Patients

The clinical exchange of information, concerns, preferences, and decisions between healthcare professionals and patients, using clear language, listening, empathy, and confirmation of understanding.

## Communicating With Someone With Aphasia

Communication strategies for a person with impaired language from brain injury or disease, including short sentences, extra time, visual cues, and supported conversation rather than assuming impaired intelligence.

## Communicating With Someone With Dysarthria

Communication strategies for a person whose speech muscles are weak or poorly coordinated, including re-

ducing background noise, confirming messages, and using writing or augmentative aids when needed.

## Community-Acquired Pneumonia In Adults

A clinical condition involving community-Acquired Pneumonia In Adults; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Complement

Complement is a system of blood proteins that enhances antibody and immune-cell defense by marking, inflaming, or directly damaging targets.

## Complement Component 3 (C3)

C3 is the central complement protein whose cleavage amplifies immune defense and whose level may fall with consumption in inflammatory or immune-complex disease.

## Complement Component 4

Complement component 4 is a protein of the classical and lectin complement pathways and may be reduced during immune-complex activation.

## Complement Fixation Test For C Burnetii

A diagnostic test used to evaluate complement fixation test for c burnetii. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## Compression Fractures Of The Back

A clinical condition or finding involving compression fractures of the back. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Compression Stockings

Elastic garments that apply graduated pressure to the legs, supporting venous return and reducing swelling or selected risks of venous pooling; correct fit and arterial circulation matter.

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## **Compulsive Gambling**

Persistent gambling with impaired control, preoccupation, chasing losses, and continued behavior despite financial, social, occupational, or emotional harm, also called gambling disorder.

### **Synonyms:**

Pathological Gambling

## **Concussion In Adults - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning concussion in adults - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Concussion In Adults - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving concussion in adults - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Concussion In Children - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning concussion in children - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Concussion In Children - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving concussion in children - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Condoms - Male**

A sheath placed over the penis during sexual activity to reduce exchange of semen and genital secretions and lower pregnancy and sexually transmitted infection risk when used correctly.

## **Cone Biopsy**

A procedure that removes a small tissue sample from the specified site for microscopic or laboratory examination.

## **Confusion**

Impaired ability to think clearly, orient, attend,

remember, or respond appropriately; sudden confusion is delirium and may indicate infection, medication effect, metabolic illness, stroke, or another emergency.

## **Congenital Antithrombin III Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving congenital antithrombin iii deficiency. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Congenital Cytomegalovirus**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by congenital cytomegalovirus. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

## **Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia Repair**

A medical procedure involving congenital diaphragmatic hernia repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

## **Congenital Fibrinogen Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving congenital fibrinogen deficiency. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Congenital Heart Defect - Corrective Surgery**

A medical procedure involving congenital heart defect - corrective surgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

## **Congenital Nephrotic Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving congenital nephrotic syndrome. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Congenital Platelet Function Defects**

A clinical condition or finding involving congenital platelet function defects. Its defining features,



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causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Congenital Protein C Or S Deficiency**

A biological or biochemical term referring to congenital protein c or s deficiency. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Congenital Rubella**

Fetal infection with rubella virus acquired during pregnancy, potentially causing hearing loss, cataracts, congenital heart disease, developmental impairment, and other findings.

### **Congenital Toxoplasmosis**

A clinical condition or finding involving congenital toxoplasmosis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Conjunctivitis Or Pink Eye**

A clinical condition or finding involving conjunctivitis or pink eye. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Conscious Sedation For Surgical Procedures**

A medical procedure involving conscious sedation for surgical procedures. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Considering Plastic Surgery After A Large Weight Loss**

A medical procedure involving considering plastic surgery after a large weight loss. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Constipation - Self-Care**

A patient-care topic concerning constipation - self-care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Constipation - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving constipation - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Constipation In Infants And Children**

Infrequent, hard, painful, or difficult passage of stool in a child, caused by stool withholding, diet, dehydration, illness, medicines, or structural and neurologic disorders.

### **Consumer Rights And Protections**

A clinical condition or finding involving consumer rights and protections. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Contac Overdose**

Overdose of a combination cold medicine that may cause acetaminophen toxicity, antihistamine or decongestant effects, sedation, seizures, or cardiac complications depending on ingredients.

### **Contracture Deformity**

A clinical condition or finding involving contracture deformity. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Controlling Your High Blood Pressure**

Long-term blood-pressure management using accurate measurement, lifestyle measures, prescribed medicines, adherence, and monitoring for complications and treatment adverse effects.

### **Cooking Utensils And Nutrition**

A patient-care topic concerning cooking utensils and nutrition. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Cooking Without Salt**

Preparing food with little or no added sodium to reduce dietary sodium intake, often useful in blood-pressure or fluid-retention management when combined with an individualized eating plan.

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## **COPD - Control Drugs**

A clinical condition or finding involving copd - control drugs. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **COPD - Managing Stress And Your Mood**

Support for anxiety, depression, and stress in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease through breathing strategies, activity, pulmonary rehabilitation, counseling, and treatment when indicated.

## **COPD - Quick-Relief Drugs**

A clinical condition or finding involving copd - quick-relief drugs. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **COPD - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving copd - what to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **COPD And Other Health Problems**

The interaction between chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and conditions such as cardiovascular disease, osteoporosis, depression, diabetes, and lung cancer, which can complicate symptoms and care.

## **COPD Flare-Ups**

Acute worsening of breathlessness, cough, or sputum beyond usual daily variation in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, often triggered by infection, pollution, or other irritants.

## **Coping With Cancer - Finding The Support You Need**

A clinical condition or finding involving coping with cancer - finding the support you need. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Coping With Cancer - Hair Loss**

A clinical condition or finding involving coping with

cancer - hair loss. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Coping With Cancer - Looking And Feeling Your Best**

A clinical condition or finding involving coping with cancer - looking and feeling your best. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Coping With Cancer - Managing Fatigue**

A clinical condition or finding involving coping with cancer - managing fatigue. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Copper In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning copper in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Copper Poisoning**

Toxic exposure to copper or copper salts that may cause vomiting, abdominal pain, hemolysis, liver injury, kidney injury, or shock.

## **Cord Blood Testing**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cord blood. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Corneal Injury**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as corneal injury. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

## **Corneal Transplant**

A medical procedure involving corneal transplant. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

## **Corneal Transplant - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving corneal transplant

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- discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Corneal Ulcers And Infections**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as corneal ulcers and infections. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Coronary Artery Fistula**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as coronary artery fistula. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Coronavirus**

A medicine or chemical compound identified by coronavirus. Its uses, effects, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical context.

### **Corticosteroids Overdose**

Overdose of corticosteroids that may cause gastrointestinal symptoms, mood changes, hyperglycemia, fluid retention, infection risk, or adrenal suppression.

### **Cortisol Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cortisol. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cortisol Urine Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cortisol urine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cosmetic Breast Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving cosmetic breast surgery - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Cosmetic Ear Surgery**

A medical procedure involving cosmetic ear surgery.

Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Could You Have Low Testosterone?**

A diagnostic test or assessment related to could you have low testosterone?. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Counting Carbohydrates**

A clinical condition or finding involving counting carbohydrates. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **COVID-19 – What To Do When You Are Sick**

Home-care and infection-control guidance for illness caused by SARS-CoV-2, including testing, staying away from others, hydration, symptom monitoring, and prompt care for breathing difficulty or high-risk disease.

### **COVID-19 Antibody Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate covid-19 antibody. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **COVID-19 Symptoms**

Symptoms of SARS-CoV-2 infection, which may include fever, cough, sore throat, congestion, fatigue, muscle aches, headache, loss of smell or taste, vomiting, or diarrhea.

### **COVID-19 Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

Information about vaccines that reduce the risk of severe COVID-19, including eligibility, updated formulations, expected reactions, rare adverse events, and the need for recommendations to change over time.

### **COVID-19 Vaccines**

Vaccines that prime immune responses against

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SARS-CoV-2 and reduce severe disease, hospitalization, and death; products, schedules, effectiveness, and recommendations vary by age and risk.

### **COVID-19 Vaccines For Children Ages 6 Months And Older**

COVID-19 vaccination guidance for children at least six months old, with product and dose schedules determined by age, prior doses, immune status, and current public-health recommendations.

### **COVID-19 Virus Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate covid-19 virus. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cow's Milk - Infants**

Guidance on cow's milk in infancy: it should not replace breast milk or iron-fortified formula before 12 months because of low iron content and risks of renal solute load and intestinal blood loss.

### **Cow's Milk And Children**

Nutritional guidance on cow's milk for children, balancing protein, calcium, vitamin D, fat, iron, allergy, and total intake so milk does not displace a varied diet.

### **CPK Isoenzymes Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate cpk isoenzymes. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **CPR - Adult And Child After Onset Of Puberty**

CPR - adult and child after onset of puberty is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **CPR - Infant**

CPR - infant is a procedure, device, treatment, or care intervention; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical goal.

### **CPR - Young Child (Age 1 Year To Onset Of Puberty)**

Cardiopulmonary resuscitation for a child from age one year until puberty who is unresponsive and not breathing normally, using emergency activation, compressions, breaths, and an AED as available.

### **Cranial Mononeuropathy III**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cranial mononeuropathy iii. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cranial Mononeuropathy III - Diabetic Type**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cranial mononeuropathy iii - diabetic type. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cranial Mononeuropathy VI**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cranial mononeuropathy vi. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cranial Sutures**

Fibrous joints between skull bones that permit molding in infancy and accommodate brain growth before progressively fusing; premature fusion causes craniosynostosis.

### **Craniosynostosis Repair**

A medical procedure involving craniosynostosis repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

### **Craniosynostosis Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving craniosynostosis repair - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient's clinical condition and the specific procedure.

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## **Craniotabes**

Soft, thin, or pliable areas of an infant's skull that indent under gentle pressure, commonly associated with normal newborn molding but also with rickets or other bone disease.

## **Creatine Phosphokinase Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate creatine phosphokinase. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Creating A Family Health History**

Collecting a record of relatives' diseases, ages at diagnosis, ancestry, and causes of death to identify inherited risk and guide screening, prevention, and genetic counseling.

## **Creatinine Blood Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate creatinine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Creatinine Clearance Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate creatinine clearance. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Creatinine Urine Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate creatinine urine. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **Creeping Eruption**

An intensely itchy winding skin track caused by larvae, usually hookworms from contaminated soil or sand, migrating within the superficial skin; it is also called cutaneous larva migrans.

## **Cribs And Crib Safety**

A patient-care topic concerning cribs and crib safety. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Crigler-Najjar Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving crigler-

najjar syndrome. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Crohn Disease - Children - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning crohn disease - children - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Crohn Disease - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning crohn disease - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Croup - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning croup - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Crush Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving crush injury. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Crutches And Children - Proper Fit And Safety Tips**

A patient-care topic concerning crutches and children - proper fit and safety tips. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Crutches And Children - Sitting And Getting Up From A Chair**

Instruction for a child using crutches to approach a chair, keep the injured limb protected as prescribed, reach for the armrests, and sit or stand safely without losing balance.

## **Crutches And Children - Stairs**

Instruction for safe stair use by a child with crutches, including handrail use, crutch placement, step sequencing, supervision, and adherence to weight-bearing restrictions.

## **Crutches And Children - Standing And**

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## **Walking**

Instruction for fitting and using crutches in children, including posture, handgrip support, gait pattern, weight-bearing limits, turning, and fall prevention.

## **Crying In Childhood**

Vocal expression of distress or emotion in a child; persistent, inconsolable, unusual, or pain-associated crying may indicate illness, injury, abuse, or unmet developmental needs.

## **Crying In Infancy**

Crying is an infant's normal communication of hunger, discomfort, fatigue, or need for contact, but sudden inconsolable crying with lethargy, fever, vomiting, or injury needs urgent assessment.

## **Cryotherapy For Prostate Cancer**

A clinical condition or finding involving cryotherapy for prostate cancer. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Cryotherapy For The Skin**

A clinical condition or finding involving cryotherapy for the skin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Cryptosporidium Enteritis**

A clinical condition or finding involving cryptosporidium enteritis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **CSF Cell Count**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as csf cell count. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

## **CSF Coccidioides Complement Fixation Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate csf coccidioides complement fixation. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **CSF Glucose Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate csf glucose. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **CSF Leak**

Escape of cerebrospinal fluid through a defect in the skull base or spinal dura, causing positional headache, clear nasal or ear drainage, wound leakage, meningitis risk, or intracranial hypotension.

## **CSF Myelin Basic Protein**

CSF myelin basic protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## **CSF Oligoclonal Banding**

An electrophoretic test for restricted immunoglobulin bands in cerebrospinal fluid, interpreted with serum bands to detect intrathecal antibody production such as in multiple sclerosis.

## **CSF Smear**

Microscopic examination of cerebrospinal fluid for cells, organisms, or abnormal material, supporting evaluation of meningitis, hemorrhage, malignancy, or inflammation.

## **CSF Total Protein**

CSF total protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## **CSF-VDRL Test**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate csf-vdrl. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

## **CT Angiography – Chest**

An imaging study of blood vessels using contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm,



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or abnormal blood flow.

### **CT Angiography - Abdomen And Pelvis**

An imaging study of blood vessels using contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or abnormal blood flow.

### **CT Angiography - Arms And Legs**

An imaging study of blood vessels using contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or abnormal blood flow.

### **CT Angiography - Head And Neck**

An imaging study of blood vessels using contrast material to identify narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or abnormal blood flow.

### **Culture - Colonic Tissue**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate culture - colonic tissue. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Culture - Duodenal Tissue**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate culture - duodenal tissue. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Culture-Negative Endocarditis**

A diagnostic test used to evaluate culture-negative endocarditis. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Curvature Of The Penis**

A bend of the erect or flaccid penis caused by congenital tissue asymmetry, scar tissue such as Peyronie disease, trauma, or other conditions; it may impair intercourse or cause pain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peyronie's Disease (Curvature Of The Penis)

### **Cushing Syndrome Due To Adrenal Tumor**

A clinical condition or finding involving cushing syndrome due to adrenal tumor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the

clinical context.

### **Cutaneous Skin Tag**

An anatomical or cellular structure referred to as cutaneous skin tag. Its clinical importance depends on its location, function, and associated disease.

### **Cuticle Remover Poisoning**

Exposure to cuticle-remover products, which may contain alkaline or acidic chemicals that can injure the skin, eyes, mouth, or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Cuts And Puncture Wounds**

A clinical condition or finding involving cuts and puncture wounds. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cyanoacrylates Poisoning**

Exposure to cyanoacrylate adhesives, commonly known as instant glue. Contact may bond tissues or irritate the skin, eyes, or airways; ingestion usually causes local adhesion or irritation.

### **Cyanotic Heart Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving cyanotic heart disease. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cyproheptadine Overdose**

Overdose of cyproheptadine, an antihistamine, that may cause sedation, agitation, anticholinergic effects, seizures, respiratory depression, or cardiac effects.

### **Cystic Fibrosis - Nutrition**

A patient-care topic concerning cystic fibrosis - nutrition. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Cystic Fibrosis - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning cystic fibrosis - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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### **Cystitis - Acute**

A clinical condition or finding involving cystitis - acute. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cystitis - Noninfectious**

A clinical condition or finding involving cystitis - noninfectious. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cystometric Study**

A diagnostic test or assessment related to cystometric study. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Cytochrome B5 Reductase**

A clinical condition or finding involving cytochrome b5 reductase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Cytologic Evaluation**

Microscopic examination of individual cells or small cell groups from a fluid, brushing, scraping, or fine-needle sample to detect infection, inflammation, or malignancy.

### **Cytology Exam Of Pleural Fluid**

Microscopic examination of fluid around the lung for malignant cells and other cellular changes, performed with chemical and microbiologic testing when evaluating an effusion.

### **Cytology Exam Of Urine**

Microscopic examination of shed urinary-tract cells, used mainly to detect high-grade urothelial malignancy and selected abnormal cells; a negative result does not exclude cancer.

### **Calcific Bursitis**

Calcific bursitis occurs when calcium deposits form in or around a bursa, often near the shoulder, causing pain and restricted movement. Treatment may include activity modification, anti-inflammatory

care, physical therapy, aspiration, injection, or removal of deposits.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bursitis Calcific (Calcific Bursitis)

### **Calcium Elevated (Hypercalcemia)**

Alternate index label for Hypercalcemia.

### **Canalith Repositioning Maneuvers**

Canalith repositioning maneuvers move displaced inner-ear crystals from a semicircular canal back to the utricle. They are used for benign paroxysmal positional vertigo, with the maneuver selected according to the affected canal and side.

### **Cancer Causes**

Cancer develops when genetic and epigenetic changes allow cells to grow, survive, and invade abnormally. Causes and risks include inherited susceptibility, tobacco, alcohol, infections, radiation, ultraviolet exposure, carcinogens, chronic inflammation, and chance changes during cell division.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer Risk (Cancer Causes)

### **Cancer Contagious (Is Cancer Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Cancer Contagious.

### **Cancer In Lung (Lung Cancer)**

Alternate index label for Lung Cancer.

### **Cancer Inflammatory Breast (Breast Cancer (Facts, Stages))**

Alternate index label for Breast Cancer (Facts, Stages).

### **Cancer Risk (Cancer Causes)**

Alternate index label for Cancer Causes.

### **Candida Infection Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children)**

Alternate index label for Thrush and Other Yeast Infections in Children.

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### **Candidal Vulvovaginitis (Yeast Infection In Women And Men)**

Alternate index label for Yeast Infection in Women and Men.

### **Canker Sores**

Canker sores are painful, shallow ulcers on the moist lining of the mouth and are not contagious. Minor trauma, stress, nutritional deficiency, immune disease, medicines, or other triggers may contribute; persistent, severe, or recurrent ulcers need evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sores Canker (Canker Sores)

### **Carbapenem Resistant Enterobacteriaceae (CRE Infection)**

Alternate index label for CRE Infection.

### **Cardiomyopathy (Restrictive)**

Alternate index label for Restrictive.

### **Cardiospasm (Achalasia)**

Alternate index label for Achalasia.

### **Causes Symptoms Of Hormonal Imbalances Women**

Hormonal imbalance in women can reflect thyroid disease, polycystic ovary syndrome, menopause, pregnancy, adrenal or pituitary disorders, medicines, or changes in body weight. Symptoms may include irregular bleeding, acne, hair changes, infertility, hot flashes, fatigue, or mood changes.

### **Cavities**

A cavity is tooth decay caused by acids produced when oral bacteria metabolize dietary carbohydrates. The process can progress from enamel demineralization to dentin and pulp infection; fluoride, oral hygiene, diet, dental sealants, fillings, or root-canal treatment may be needed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental Caries (Cavities)

### **Celiac Disease (Gluten Enteropathy)**

Alternate index label for Gluten Enteropathy.

### **Cells Stem (Stem Cells)**

Alternate index label for Stem Cells.

### **Central Precocious Puberty**

Central precocious puberty begins when the hypothalamus and pituitary activate the normal puberty pathway unusually early. It causes early secondary sexual characteristics and accelerated bone maturation; evaluation identifies causes and treatment may delay progression when appropriate.

### **Cerebrovascular Accident (Stroke Symptoms And Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Stroke Symptoms and Treatment.

### **Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia)**

Alternate index label for Cervical Dysplasia.

### **Cervical Pain (Neck Pain)**

Alternate index label for Neck Pain.

### **CFS (Chronic Fatigue Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Chronic Fatigue Syndrome.

### **Chemotherapy Treatment**

Chemotherapy uses medicines that damage or inhibit rapidly dividing cancer cells. It may be given before or after local treatment, for advanced disease, or for symptom control; effects and monitoring depend on the drugs, cancer, treatment goal, and organ function.

### **Chest Pain On The Left Side Above A Female Breast**

Left-sided chest or breast-area pain can arise from muscle or rib injury, breast tissue, reflux, lung disease, anxiety, or heart disease. Pressure, exertional pain, shortness of breath, sweating, faintness, or pain spreading to the arm or jaw requires emergency assessment.

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### **CHF (Congestive Heart Failure (CHF) Overview)**

Alternate index label for Congestive Heart Failure (CHF) Overview.

### **Chickenpox (Varicella)**

Alternate index label for Varicella.

### **Chickenpox Contagious (Is Chickenpox Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Chickenpox Contagious.

### **Chiggers (Bites)**

Alternate index label for Bites.

### **Chikungunya Virus Infection**

Chikungunya is a mosquito-borne viral infection that usually causes abrupt fever and severe joint pain, sometimes with rash, headache, or conjunctivitis. Joint symptoms can persist; care is supportive, mosquito exposure should be reduced, and severe illness requires assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Infection Chikungunya (Chikungunya Virus Infection)

### **Child Abuse Facts**

Child abuse includes physical or emotional harm, sexual abuse, exploitation, or neglect by a caregiver or other person. Possible signs include unexplained injuries, developmental change, fear, poor hygiene, or inconsistent explanations; suspected abuse should be reported through local protection services or emergency channels.

#### **Synonyms:**

Abuse Child (Child Abuse Facts)

### **Children Autism (Autism And Communication)**

Alternate index label for Autism and Communication.

### **Children Dementia (Dementia)**

Alternate index label for Dementia.

### **Children Night Sweats (Night Sweats)**

Alternate index label for Night Sweats.

### **Children Seizures (Febrile Seizures)**

Alternate index label for Febrile Seizures.

### **Children Separation Anxiety (Separation Anxiety)**

Alternate index label for Separation Anxiety.

### **Children Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

### **Children's Cough Causes And Treatments**

Children cough with viral infection, asthma, allergies, reflux, airway irritation, or an inhaled object. Treatment depends on cause and age; breathing difficulty, stridor, blue color, dehydration, sudden onset, or a cough lasting beyond expected recovery needs medical evaluation.

### **Children's Health**

Children's health includes growth, development, nutrition, immunization, sleep, mental health, injury prevention, and management of acute or chronic illness. Care is guided by developmental stage, family context, preventive visits, and early recognition of concerning changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Childrens Health (Children's Health)

### **Childrens Health (Children's Health)**

Alternate index label for Children's Health.

### **Chlamydia Bacteria Infection (Chlamydia In Women Overview)**

Alternate index label for Chlamydia in Women Overview.

### **Chlamydia In Women Overview**

Chlamydia is a sexually transmitted infection caused by Chlamydia trachomatis and may cause no symp-

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toms. Untreated infection can lead to cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, infertility, ectopic pregnancy, or infection in a newborn; testing and treatment of partners are important.

**Synonyms:**

Chlamydia Bacteria Infection (Chlamydia In Women Overview)

**Chloasma (Melasma)**

Alternate index label for Melasma.

**Cholangiocarcinoma (Bile Duct Cancer (Cholangiocarcinoma))**

Alternate index label for Bile Duct Cancer (Cholangiocarcinoma).

**Choledochal Cysts**

Choledochal cysts are congenital or acquired dilations of the bile ducts that can cause abdominal pain, jaundice, pancreatitis, cholangitis, or stones. Imaging establishes the anatomy, and surgical removal is often recommended because of recurrent complications and cancer risk.

**Synonyms:**

Cysts Choledochal (Choledochal Cysts)

**Cholelithiasis (Gallstones)**

Alternate index label for Gallstones.

**Cholera Contagious (Is Cholera Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Cholera Contagious.

**Cholesterol Lowering (Cholesterol Management)**

Alternate index label for Cholesterol Management.

**Cholesterol Management**

Cholesterol management combines cardiovascular-risk assessment with dietary pattern, physical activity, tobacco avoidance, weight care, and medicines when indicated. Statins and other agents lower atherogenic lipoproteins, with intensity chosen according to prior cardiovascular disease and overall risk.

**Synonyms:**

Cholesterol Lowering (Cholesterol Management)

**Chorioretinitis (Uveitis)**

Alternate index label for Uveitis.

**Chorioretinitis Toxoplasma (Toxoplasmosis)**

Alternate index label for Toxoplasmosis.

**Chronic Inflammatory Response Syndrome (CIRS)**

Alternate index label for CIRS.

**Churg Strauss Syndrome (Churg-Strauss Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Churg-Strauss Syndrome.

**Ciguatera Poisoning**

Ciguatera poisoning follows eating reef fish containing ciguatoxins. Gastrointestinal symptoms may be followed by neurologic sensations such as temperature reversal, tingling, itching, weakness, or abnormal heart rate; treatment is supportive and prevention depends on avoiding high-risk fish.

**Synonyms:**

Poisoning Ciguatera (Ciguatera Poisoning) Toxin Ciguatera (Ciguatera Poisoning)

**Cirrhosis Primary Biliary (Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC))**

Alternate index label for Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC).

**Cleft Palate And Cleft Lip**

Cleft lip and cleft palate are congenital openings caused by incomplete fusion of facial structures during development. They can affect feeding, speech, hearing, teeth, and breathing and are managed by coordinated surgical, dental, speech, hearing, and nutritional care.

**Clinical Depression (Depression)**

Alternate index label for Depression.

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### **Clostridium Difficile Colitis**

*Clostridioides difficile* colitis is antibiotic-associated inflammation of the colon caused by toxin-producing bacteria. It causes watery diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, and sometimes severe colitis; diagnosis and treatment depend on symptoms, testing, recurrence, and severity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Difficile *Clostridium* (*Clostridium Difficile Colitis*)

### **Clot Blood (Blood Clots)**

Alternate index label for Blood Clots.

### **Club Drugs List And Side Effects**

Club drugs include substances such as MDMA, ketamine, GHB, and others used recreationally in social settings. Effects may include agitation, hallucinations, seizures, dangerous temperature elevation, respiratory depression, cardiovascular toxicity, impaired consent, and overdose.

### **Cluster Headaches**

Cluster headache causes repeated attacks of severe one-sided orbital or temporal pain with tearing, nasal symptoms, eyelid drooping, or restlessness. Attacks occur in bouts and require targeted acute and preventive treatment; a first sudden severe headache needs urgent evaluation.

### **CMV (Cytomegalovirus (CMV))**

Alternate index label for Cytomegalovirus (CMV).

### **Coats Disease (Coats' Disease)**

Alternate index label for Coats' Disease.

### **Cocaine And Crack Abuse**

Cocaine and crack use can cause dependence, agitation, paranoia, seizures, stroke, heart attack, dangerous arrhythmias, pregnancy complications, and nasal or lung injury. Treatment combines safety assessment, management of intoxication or withdrawal, behavioral care, and support for substance-use disorder.

### **Cold (Common Cold)**

Alternate index label for Common Cold.

### **Cold And Cough Medicine For Infants And Children**

Many nonprescription cold and cough medicines are unsafe or ineffective for young children and can cause sedation, agitation, abnormal heart rate, overdose, or breathing problems. Age-appropriate fluids, saline, humidification, and clinician-guided treatment are safer approaches.

### **Cold Flu Allergy Treatments (Cold, Flu, Allergy)**

Alternate index label for Cold, Flu, Allergy.

### **Cold Sore Vs. Pimple (Pimple Vs Cold Sore)**

Alternate index label for Pimple vs Cold Sore.

### **Cold, Flu, Allergy**

Colds, influenza, and allergies can all cause nasal symptoms and cough but differ in cause, fever pattern, duration, and contagiousness. Viral illness usually improves with supportive care, while allergies respond to trigger reduction and appropriate antihistamine or nasal treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cold Flu Allergy Treatments (Cold, Flu, Allergy)

### **Colitis Collagenous (Lymphocytic Colitis)**

Alternate index label for Lymphocytic Colitis.

### **Colitis Contagious (Is Colitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Colitis Contagious.

### **Colitis Lymphocytic (Lymphocytic Colitis)**

Alternate index label for Lymphocytic Colitis.

### **Colitis Microscopic (Lymphocytic Colitis)**

Alternate index label for Lymphocytic Colitis.

### **Colitis Ulcerative (Ulcerative Colitis)**

Alternate index label for Ulcerative Colitis.



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## Colon Cancer Prevention

Colorectal-cancer risk can be reduced through recommended screening, physical activity, healthy weight, limiting alcohol, avoiding tobacco, and a diet rich in fiber-containing plant foods. Screening can detect precancerous polyps and early cancer before symptoms develop.

## Colonic Diverticulitis (Diverticulosis)

Alternate index label for Diverticulosis.

## Colorectal Cancer (Colon Cancer)

Alternate index label for Colon Cancer.

## Coma Diabetic (Diabetic Ketoacidosis)

Alternate index label for Diabetic Ketoacidosis.

## Coma Myxedema (Myxedema Coma)

Alternate index label for Myxedema Coma.

## Common Cold Stages And Timeline Of Symptoms

The common cold often begins with sore throat, sneezing, or fatigue, followed by nasal congestion, runny nose, and cough. Symptoms usually peak within several days and improve over one to two weeks, although cough and fatigue may last longer.

## Common Early Symptoms Of Myasthenia Gravis

Early myasthenia gravis commonly causes fluctuating, fatigable weakness of the eyelids, eye movements, facial muscles, chewing, swallowing, speech, neck, or limbs. Symptoms worsen with use and improve with rest; breathing or swallowing difficulty is an emergency.

## Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms

Medical abbreviations and terms summarize diagnoses, tests, medicines, anatomy, and treatment instructions. Because abbreviations can be ambiguous or unsafe, patients should ask clinicians or pharmacists to explain unfamiliar wording rather than infer its meaning.

## Synonyms:

Abbreviations Medical Terms (Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms) Terms Medical Abbreviations (Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms)

## Compulsive Obsessive Disorder (Obsessive Compulsive Disorder (OCD))

Alternate index label for Obsessive Compulsive Disorder (OCD).

## Conditions Caused By Deletion Mutations

Deletion mutations remove DNA segments and can disrupt one gene or several neighboring genes. The clinical effect depends on size, location, inheritance, and whether the remaining copy compensates; genetic counseling and testing may clarify diagnosis and recurrence risk.

## Congenital Megacolon (Hirschsprung Disease)

Alternate index label for Hirschsprung Disease.

## Congestive Heart Failure (CHF) Overview

Alternate index label for CHF) Overvie.

## Conjunctivitis (Pink Eye)

Alternate index label for Pink Eye.

## Constipation (Laxatives For Constipation)

Alternate index label for Laxatives For Constipation.

## Constipation Foods To Avoid (Top Foods That Cause Constipation)

Alternate index label for Top Foods That Cause Constipation.

## Constipation Home Remedies (Constipation)

Alternate index label for Constipation.

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**Consumption (Tuberculosis (TB) Facts)**

Alternate index label for Tuberculosis (TB) Facts.

**Contagious C. Diff Clostridium Difficile (Is C Diff Clostridium Difficile Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is C diff Clostridium difficile Contagious.

**Contagious Canker Sores (Are Canker Sores Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Are Canker Sores Contagious.

**Contagious Cough (Is A Cough Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Cough Contagious.

**Contagious Diverticulitis (Is Diverticulitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Diverticulitis Contagious.

**Contagious E. Coli (Is E Coli Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is E coli Contagious.

**Contagious H. Pylori (Is H Pylori Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is H pylori contagious.

**Contagious Hepatitis (Is Hepatitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Hepatitis Contagious.

**Contagious Hepatitis A (Is Hepatitis A Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Hepatitis A Contagious.

**Contagious Hepatitis B (Is Hepatitis B Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Hepatitis B Contagious.

**Contagious Hepatitis C (Is Hepatitis C****Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Hepatitis C Contagious.

**Contagious Sinus Infection (Is A Sinus Infection Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Sinus Infection Contagious.

**Contagious Sore Throat (Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious.

**Contagious Strep Throat (Is Strep Throat Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Strep Throat Contagious.

**Contagious Tonsillitis (Is Tonsillitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Tonsillitis Contagious.

**Contagious Yeast (Is A Yeast Infection Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Yeast Infection Contagious.

**Contagious Yeast Infection (Is A Yeast Infection Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Yeast Infection Contagious.

**Contractions Braxton-Hicks (Braxton Hicks Contractions)**

Alternate index label for Braxton Hicks Contractions.

**COPD (Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease)**

Alternate index label for Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease.

**COPD (COPD (Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease))**

Alternate index label for COPD (Chronic Obstruc-

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tive Pulmonary Disease).

### **COPD Vs. Asthma Differences And Similarities**

Asthma usually has variable, reversible airway narrowing, while chronic obstructive pulmonary disease causes persistent airflow limitation associated most often with smoking or long-term irritant exposure. Both can cause cough and wheeze, but testing, course, and treatment differ.

### **COPD Vs. Emphysema Differences Similarities**

Emphysema is structural destruction of alveoli and one component of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. COPD may also include chronic bronchitis and small-airway disease; symptoms, spirometry, imaging, exposure history, and exacerbations guide distinction and care.

### **Corneal Disease**

Corneal disease affects the transparent front surface of the eye through infection, inflammation, trauma, dystrophy, degeneration, dryness, or abnormal shape. Pain, redness, light sensitivity, discharge, or reduced vision can signal urgent disease because scarring may impair sight.

### **Corneal Inflammation (Keratitis)**

Alternate index label for Keratitis.

### **Corns**

A corn is a localized thickening of skin caused by repeated pressure or friction, commonly on toes or other weight-bearing areas. Proper footwear, pressure relief, and treatment of the underlying deformity help; diabetes or poor circulation makes self-removal risky.

### **Correct Code For Diagnostic Dilation And Curettage**

Dilation and curettage is a procedure that opens the cervix and removes tissue from the uterus for diagnosis or treatment. Coding depends on the indication, setting, technique, pregnancy status, and tissue findings and should be assigned from the

documented procedure.

### **Cosmetic Allergies**

Cosmetic products can cause irritant dermatitis or allergic contact dermatitis, producing itching, redness, swelling, scaling, or blistering where applied. Stopping the suspected product and medical assessment, sometimes with patch testing, help identify the responsible ingredient.

### **Costochondritis (Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Costochondritis and Tietze Syndrome.

### **Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome**

Costochondritis is inflammation or irritation at the junction of ribs and the breastbone, causing reproducible chest-wall pain. Tietze syndrome is a less common related condition with visible swelling at one or a few joints; heart and lung emergencies must still be excluded.

#### **Synonyms:**

Costochondritis (Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome) Tietze Syndrome (Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome)

### **Cough Chronic (Chronic Cough)**

Alternate index label for Chronic Cough.

### **Could A Stiff Neck Be A Sign Of Something Serious**

Neck stiffness commonly follows muscle strain, but stiffness with fever, severe headache, light sensitivity, confusion, rash, weakness, trauma, or neurologic change can signal meningitis, bleeding, spinal injury, or another emergency.

### **COVID-19 Prevention Tips**

COVID-19 prevention combines staying current with recommended vaccination, improving indoor ventilation, avoiding close exposure when ill, testing when indicated, masking in higher-risk settings, and hand or respiratory hygiene. Recommendations change with local transmission and individual risk.

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### **COVID-19 Vs. Allergies**

COVID-19 may cause fever, sore throat, cough, fatigue, body aches, or loss of smell, while allergies more often cause itching, sneezing, watery eyes, and recurrent symptoms without fever. Testing and exposure history help distinguish them.

### **COVID-19 Vs. Flu Vs. Cold**

COVID-19, influenza, and common colds overlap in respiratory symptoms and cannot always be distinguished by symptoms alone. Testing, exposure, season, severity, and risk factors guide diagnosis; breathing difficulty, chest pain, confusion, or dehydration requires urgent care.

### **Coxsackie (Coxsackie Virus)**

Alternate index label for Coxsackie Virus.

### **CPT Code For Foreign Body Removal From The Ear**

Removal of an ear foreign body is coded according to the documented method, location, anesthesia, complications, and whether a separate evaluation was performed. Objects causing pain, bleeding, hearing loss, or suspected eardrum injury should be removed by a trained clinician.

### **Cramps But No Period**

Pelvic cramps without menstruation can result from ovulation, pregnancy, implantation, constipation, urinary disease, infection, endometriosis, cysts, or other pelvic conditions. Severe one-sided pain, faintness, fever, vomiting, or possible pregnancy requires urgent assessment.

### **Cramps Heat (Heat Cramps)**

Alternate index label for Heat Cramps.

### **Cramps Menstrual (Menstrual Cramps)**

Alternate index label for Menstrual Cramps.

### **CRE Infection**

Carbapenem-resistant Enterobacterales are bacteria resistant to important antibiotics and can cause urinary, bloodstream, abdominal, wound, or lung

infections. Infection-control precautions, culture-based treatment, and specialist advice are important because therapeutic options may be limited.

### **Synonyms:**

Carbapenem Resistant Enterobacteriaceae (CRE Infection)

### **Critical Limb Ischemia Vs. Acute Limb Ischemia**

Chronic limb-threatening ischemia develops gradually from severe arterial disease and causes rest pain, nonhealing wounds, or tissue loss. Acute limb ischemia occurs suddenly with pain, pallor, pulselessness, numbness, weakness, or coldness and requires emergency revascularization assessment.

### **Crohn Disease (Crohn's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Crohn's Disease.

### **Crohns Disease Vs Ulcerative Colitis UC**

Crohn disease can affect any part of the gastrointestinal tract and often involves patchy, full-thickness inflammation, while ulcerative colitis affects the colon continuously from the rectum with superficial mucosal inflammation. Symptoms overlap, but imaging, endoscopy, and biopsy help distinguish them.

### **Crohn's Disease Cause Dark Circles Around Eyes**

Crohn disease does not directly cause dark circles in every patient, but anemia, fatigue, dehydration, poor sleep, nutritional deficiency, steroid effects, or atopic skin may contribute. Persistent pallor, fatigue, weight loss, bleeding, or active bowel symptoms deserve clinical review.

### **Croup Contagious (Is Croup Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Croup Contagious.

### **Ctenocephalides FelFlea Bite (Flea Bites In Humans)**

Alternate index label for Flea Bites in Humans.

### **Cuts Wounds (Cuts, Scrapes And**

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### **Puncture Wounds)**

Alternate index label for Cuts, Scrapes and Puncture Wounds.

### **Cuts, Scrapes And Puncture Wounds**

Cuts, scrapes, and puncture wounds damage the skin to varying depths and can introduce bacteria or foreign material. Clean minor wounds with running water, control bleeding, cover them, and seek care for deep or contaminated wounds, bites, impaired circulation, infection, or uncertain tetanus protection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cuts Wounds (Cuts, Scrapes And Puncture Wounds)

### **CVA (Stroke Symptoms And Treatment)**

Alternate index label for Stroke Symptoms and Treatment.

### **Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome (CVS)**

Alternate index label for CVS.

### **Cyclospora Infection (Cyclosporiasis)**

Alternate index label for Cyclosporiasis.

### **Cyst Eyelid (Giardia Lamblia)**

Alternate index label for Giardia Lamblia.

### **Cystic Acne**

Cystic acne is severe inflammatory acne with deep painful nodules or cyst-like lesions that can scar. Treatment may require prescription retinoids, antimicrobial or hormonal therapy, or isotretinoin under specialist monitoring; squeezing lesions increases scarring.

### **Cystitis (Bladder Infection)**

Cystitis is inflammation of the bladder, most often from a bacterial urinary-tract infection. It causes burning urination, frequency, urgency, and lower-abdominal discomfort; fever, flank pain, vomiting, pregnancy, or recurrent infection requires prompt assessment.

### **Cysts Choledochal (Choledochal Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Choledochal Cysts.

### **Cysts Ovary (Ovarian Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Ovarian Cysts.

### **Cysts Pancreatic Inflammatory (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

### **Cysts True Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

### **Cytomegalovirus (CMV)**

Alternate index label for CMV.

### **C-Reactive Protein Test (CRP)**

A blood test measuring C-reactive protein, an acute-phase protein that rises with inflammation; it is nonspecific and must be interpreted with symptoms and other findings.

### **C1-C7 (Cervical Vertebrae)**

The seven vertebrae of the neck, numbered C1 through C7; they support the head, protect the cervical spinal cord, and allow neck movement.

### **CA**

A medical abbreviation that may mean cancer, carcinoma, or calcium; the intended meaning depends on the surrounding clinical context.

### **CA 27-29**

A blood tumor-marker test measuring a form of the MUC1 antigen, used mainly to monitor some people with breast cancer rather than to screen for cancer by itself.

### **Cachectic**

Affected by cachexia, a severe wasting syndrome involving involuntary weight loss, muscle loss, weakness, and often reduced appetite in chronic disease.

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## **Cachetic**

An alternate spelling of cachectic, meaning characterized by severe disease-related wasting and loss of muscle and body mass.

## **CAD**

Coronary artery disease, narrowing or blockage of the heart's arteries, usually from atherosclerotic plaque, that can cause angina or myocardial infarction.

## **Caduceus**

A staff with two entwined snakes and wings, traditionally associated with Hermes; it is often used as a medical symbol but is distinct from the single-snake Rod of Asclepius.

## **Caecal**

Relating to the cecum, the pouch at the beginning of the large intestine where the small intestine joins the colon.

## **Caecum**

The first pouch-like part of the large intestine, located where the ileum joins the colon and attached to the appendix.

## **Cal (Calorie)**

A unit of energy; in nutrition, a Calorie with a capital C is a kilocalorie equal to 1,000 small calories and is used to describe food energy.

## **Calcaneal Spur**

A bony outgrowth from the heel bone, often at the plantar fascia attachment or Achilles tendon attachment; it may be asymptomatic or associated with heel pain.

## **Calcified Granuloma**

A healed granulomatous inflammatory lesion in which calcium has been deposited, commonly seen as a small calcified focus in the lung or another organ.

## **Calcium Channel Blocker**

A drug that inhibits calcium entry through L-type calcium channels, relaxing vascular smooth muscle and, for some agents, slowing cardiac conduction and reducing contractility.

## **Calcium Deficiency**

Inadequate calcium intake or availability; severe deficiency can contribute to hypocalcemia, muscle spasms, impaired bone mineralization, and increased fracture risk.

## **Calculus, Renal**

A kidney stone, a hard mass of mineral crystals formed in the urinary tract that may cause colicky pain, hematuria, obstruction, or infection.

## **Calf**

The posterior portion of the lower leg between the knee and ankle, containing the gastrocnemius, soleus, and other muscles.

## **Calipers**

An instrument with opposing arms used to measure distance, thickness, or body dimensions, including skinfold thickness in nutritional assessment.

## **Calor**

Heat or increased warmth of a body part, one of the classic local signs of inflammation.

## **Calor, Dolor, Rubor, And Tumor**

The classic signs of inflammation: heat, pain, redness, and swelling; inflammation may also impair function.

## **Cannabinoid Hyperemesis Syndrome (CHS)**

A syndrome of recurrent severe nausea, vomiting, and abdominal pain associated with prolonged frequent cannabis use; symptoms often improve after sustained cannabis cessation.

## **Caps**

A prescription abbreviation for capsules, oral dosage



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forms in which medicine is enclosed in a soluble shell.

### **Carboxyhemoglobinemia**

An abnormally high level of carboxyhemoglobin formed when carbon monoxide binds hemoglobin, reducing oxygen delivery and impairing oxygen release to tissues.

### **Carcinogenic**

Capable of causing or promoting cancer through genetic damage, altered cell regulation, or other mechanisms.

### **Cardiopathy**

Any disease or disorder of the heart, including diseases of the heart muscle, valves, coronary arteries, rhythm, or congenital structure.

### **Carotid**

Relating to either of the major arteries in the neck that carry blood from the heart toward the brain and head.

### **Cascade**

A sequence in which one activated reaction or event triggers the next, such as the coagulation, complement, or inflammatory cascade.

### **Caseous**

Having a cheese-like appearance or consistency, especially the necrotic material typical of some tuberculosis granulomas.

### **Cashew Allergy**

An immune reaction to cashew proteins that can cause hives, swelling, vomiting, wheezing, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

### **Cassette**

A holder or container for recording or imaging material; in radiography, a cassette traditionally houses the film or image receptor during exposure.

### **CAT Scan**

Computed axial tomography, commonly called CT,

an imaging method that uses multiple X-ray measurements and computer processing to create cross-sectional body images.

### **Cataplasm**

A poultice: a soft, moist substance spread on cloth and applied to the body, historically for soothing, warming, or treating a local condition.

### **Category Five Hurricane**

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of at least 157 miles per hour (252 km/h), capable of catastrophic damage and prolonged loss of habitability.

### **Category Three Hurricane**

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of 111–129 miles per hour (178–208 km/h), capable of devastating damage.

### **Category Two Hurricane**

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of 96–110 miles per hour (154–177 km/h), capable of extensive damage to structures and vegetation.

### **Catheter, Foley**

An indwelling urinary catheter with an inflatable balloon that holds it in the bladder, allowing continuous drainage of urine.

### **Caudad**

Toward the tail or lower end of the body; in humans, it generally means toward the feet or away from the head.

### **CCD (Cleidocranial Dysostosis)**

A usually inherited skeletal disorder, often caused by RUNX2 variants, characterized by hypoplastic or absent clavicles, delayed closure of skull sutures, short stature, and dental abnormalities.

### **CCP**

Cyclic citrullinated peptide; anti-CCP antibody testing supports diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis and may help assess the likelihood of erosive disease.

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## **CDC**

The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, a U.S. public-health agency that conducts disease surveillance and issues health guidance.

## **Centimeter (Cm)**

A unit of length equal to one hundredth of a meter, or 10 millimeters.

## **Central Line**

A catheter inserted into a large vein with its tip in or near the heart, used to give medications or nutrition, draw blood, or monitor central venous pressures.

## **Central Nervous System (CNS)**

The brain and spinal cord, which receive, process, and coordinate sensory, motor, cognitive, and autonomic functions.

## **Central Venous Line**

A vascular catheter whose tip lies in a major central vein, commonly the superior vena cava, for reliable long-term or high-concentration intravenous access.

## **Central Vision**

Detailed vision directed at the point of gaze, provided primarily by the macula and fovea; it is needed for reading and recognizing faces.

## **Centric-Fusion Translocation**

A Robertsonian translocation in which the long arms of two acrocentric chromosomes fuse near their centromeres, leaving a combined chromosome and usually losing the short arms.

## **Cephal-**

A combining form meaning head.

## **Cephalic**

Relating to the head or toward the head; in obstetrics, a cephalic presentation means the fetus presents head first.

## **Cerebral**

Relating to the cerebrum or, more broadly, to the brain.

## **Cerebrovascular Accident (CVA) Prevention**

Measures to reduce the risk of stroke, including controlling blood pressure, diabetes, and lipids, avoiding tobacco, treating atrial fibrillation when indicated, and using appropriate antithrombotic therapy.

## **Cervical Dystocia**

Failure of the uterine cervix to dilate normally during labor, which can delay or prevent vaginal delivery.

## **Chain-Termination Codon**

A codon that signals the end of protein translation; the three standard stop codons are UAA, UAG, and UGA in messenger RNA.

## **Charcot-Wilbrand Syndrome**

A rare neuropsychiatric syndrome after brain injury characterized by loss of visual imagery and visual dreaming, sometimes with difficulty recognizing or interpreting visual information.

## **Chargaff Rule**

The observation that double-stranded DNA contains approximately equal amounts of adenine and thymine and of guanine and cytosine, reflecting complementary base pairing.

## **Chasing The Dragon**

Inhalation of vapor produced by heating heroin, a method of drug use that can cause dependence, overdose, toxic exposures, and neurological injury.

## **Chemo**

Informal shorthand for chemotherapy, treatment using drugs that destroy cancer cells, inhibit their growth, or suppress abnormal immune cells.

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## **Chest**

The thorax, the region between the neck and abdomen containing the heart, lungs, major vessels, and other structures protected by the ribs and sternum.

## **CHF**

Congestive heart failure, a syndrome in which the heart cannot pump or fill adequately, causing symptoms such as breathlessness, fatigue, and fluid retention.

## **Child Health**

The physical, developmental, mental, and social well-being of children, including prevention, nutrition, immunization, safety, and treatment of illness.

## **Childbed Fever**

Puerperal fever, usually infection of the reproductive tract after childbirth or miscarriage, often involving postpartum endometritis and requiring prompt evaluation and treatment.

## **Childhood**

The developmental period between infancy and adolescence, during which physical growth, brain development, learning, and social skills progress.

## **Chinese Restaurant Syndrome**

An older, controversial term for short-lived symptoms such as headache, flushing, or palpitations attributed to eating restaurant food; evidence does not show that monosodium glutamate causes these symptoms in most people at usual dietary exposures.

## **Chloride**

The principal negatively charged electrolyte in extracellular fluid, important for fluid balance, electrical neutrality, and gastric acid formation.

## **Cholangi-**

A combining form meaning bile duct or bile vessel.

## **Cholecyst**

The gallbladder, a small sac beneath the liver that stores and concentrates bile.

## **Chondroitin Sulfate**

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan found in cartilage and other connective tissues; it is also marketed in supplements for osteoarthritis, with variable evidence of benefit.

## **Chromosome Complement**

The complete set of chromosomes in a cell, including their number and sex-chromosome composition, usually described by a karyotype.

## **Chromosome Duplication**

A structural chromosome abnormality in which a segment of genetic material is copied one or more additional times, potentially altering gene dosage and development.

## **Chronic Disease**

A disease or condition that persists for a prolonged period, often months or years, and may require continuing monitoring or management.

## **Chronic Glomerulonephritis**

Long-standing inflammation and scarring of the kidney glomeruli that can progressively reduce filtration and lead to chronic kidney disease or kidney failure.

## **Chronicity**

The duration or long-standing nature of a disease, symptom, or process.

## **Chyle**

Milky lymph from intestinal lymphatic vessels that is rich in absorbed dietary fat and transported through the thoracic duct.

## **Ci (Curie)**

A unit of radioactivity equal to 3.7 billion nuclear disintegrations per second; the SI unit is the becquerel.

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**CIC**

Commonly, clean intermittent catheterization: periodic insertion of a catheter to empty the bladder, followed by removal; other expansions are possible by context.

**Cidal**

A suffix meaning killing or destroying, as in bactericidal or fungicidal.

**Cide**

A suffix meaning an agent or process that kills, as in pesticide, bactericide, or homicide.

**Cigarette**

A small cylinder of tobacco or other material wrapped in paper for smoking; smoke exposure delivers nicotine and many toxic and carcinogenic substances.

**Ciguatoxin**

A heat-stable toxin produced by marine microorganisms and accumulated in some reef fish, causing ciguatera poisoning with gastrointestinal, neurologic, and temperature-sensation symptoms.

**Ciliary Muscle**

A ring of smooth muscle in the eye that changes the lens shape for focusing at different distances and helps regulate aqueous humor outflow through ciliary-body structures.

**Ciliary Neuralgia**

Pain arising from or felt along the ciliary nerves around the eye, often described as deep orbital or eye pain; the cause requires clinical evaluation.

**Cinacalcet**

A calcimimetic drug that activates calcium-sensing receptors and lowers parathyroid hormone, used for selected forms of hyperparathyroidism and hypercalcemia.

**Circulation**

Continuous movement of blood through the heart

and blood vessels, or of lymph through lymphatic vessels, to transport oxygen, nutrients, hormones, and waste.

**Circulatory**

Relating to the movement of blood or lymph and to the organs and vessels that carry them.

**Circulatory System**

The heart and blood-vessel network that pumps and distributes blood through pulmonary and systemic circuits; broadly, the term may include the lymphatic system.

**Circum-**

A combining form meaning around or surrounding.

**Circumflex**

Curving around; the circumflex coronary artery is a branch of the left coronary artery that travels around the heart's lateral and posterior surface.

**Cisplatin**

A platinum-based chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used to treat several cancers; important toxicities include kidney injury, hearing loss, neuropathy, and nausea.

**Cl (Chloride)**

The chemical symbol for chloride, the negatively charged ion of chlorine and a major extracellular electrolyte.

**CLA**

An abbreviation that commonly means conjugated linoleic acid, a group of fatty-acid isomers; in other medical contexts it may have a different expansion.

**Clark Level Of Invasion**

A historical five-level system describing how deeply a melanoma has invaded skin layers; modern melanoma staging relies primarily on tumor thickness, ulceration, and other prognostic factors.

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## **Clinical**

Relating to direct observation, examination, diagnosis, or treatment of a patient, rather than solely to laboratory or basic research findings.

## **Clinical Disease**

Disease that produces recognizable signs or symptoms or other findings detectable in a patient, as opposed to a silent or subclinical state.

## **Clinical Trials**

Research studies involving human participants that evaluate the safety, effectiveness, risks, or best use of medical interventions or health strategies.

## **Clinophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of going to bed or being in bed, sometimes associated with fear of sleep or nighttime.

## **CLIP**

A device used to hold tissue or structures together; surgical clips can close blood vessels, mark tissue, or occlude structures such as the vas deferens.

## **Clitoral**

Relating to the clitoris, an erectile organ with a dense concentration of sensory nerves at the front of the vulva.

## **Clitorectomy**

Surgical removal of all or part of the clitoris, sometimes with removal of adjacent vulvar tissue; nonconsensual forms constitute female genital mutilation and can cause serious harm.

## **Cluster**

A group of similar events, findings, cells, or cases occurring together in space, time, or clinical pattern.

## **Cm (Centimeter)**

The abbreviation for centimeter, a unit of length equal to one hundredth of a meter or 10 millimeters.

## **CNS (Central Nervous System)**

The brain and spinal cord, which form the central processing and control system of the nervous system.

## **Coagulation**

The process by which blood changes from a liquid to a clot through platelet activity and activation of the coagulation proteins, producing a fibrin mesh.

## **Cobalamin**

Vitamin B12, a vitamin required for DNA synthesis, red-blood-cell formation, and normal neurologic function.

## **Cocaine**

A stimulant drug that blocks monoamine reuptake and can also act as a local anesthetic; use can cause dependence, cardiovascular complications, seizures, stroke, and overdose.

## **Coccus**

A spherical or approximately round bacterium; cocci may occur singly, in pairs, chains, or clusters.

## **Code Black**

A hospital emergency alert whose meaning varies by institution, often indicating a severe security threat, bomb threat, or other critical incident; local policy determines the response.

## **Code, Hospital**

A standardized hospital announcement used to summon a specialized response to an emergency; the meaning of each code depends on the hospital's policy.

## **Coenzyme Q10**

CoQ10, a lipid-soluble compound in mitochondrial electron transport and an antioxidant; it is also sold as a dietary supplement, although benefits vary by condition.

## **Cognitive**

Relating to mental processes such as attention, memory, learning, language, reasoning, perception, and

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decision-making.

### **Cognitive Therapy**

A psychological treatment that helps a person identify and change unhelpful thoughts and beliefs and develop more adaptive behaviors; cognitive behavioral therapy combines it with behavioral methods.

### **Cohort**

A group of people who share a defined characteristic or experience during a specified period and are studied over time or compared with another group.

### **Coitophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of sexual intercourse, which may cause avoidance, distress, or difficulty in intimate relationships.

### **Coitus**

Sexual intercourse, traditionally referring to penile-vaginal penetration; sexual activity is broader than this term.

### **Coitus Interruptus**

The withdrawal method of contraception, in which the penis is removed from the vagina before ejaculation; it is less reliable than many other contraceptive methods.

### **Coke**

Slang for cocaine, a stimulant drug; the word can also mean a carbon fuel product, so context is essential.

### **COLD (Chronic Obstructive Lung Disease)**

An older abbreviation for chronic obstructive lung disease, now usually called chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD), characterized by persistent airflow limitation.

### **Coliform**

A group of generally gram-negative bacteria that ferment lactose with acid and gas production under defined laboratory conditions; their presence in wa-

ter can indicate fecal contamination, although not all coliforms are fecal pathogens.

### **Collateral**

Providing an alternative or parallel route, such as collateral blood vessels that supply tissue around an obstruction; in other contexts it means accompanying or secondary.

### **Colpo-**

A combining form meaning vagina.

### **Commensal**

Describing an organism that lives with another organism and benefits from the relationship without normally harming or helping the host; normal skin and intestinal flora may be commensal.

### **Complementary Medicine**

Health practices used together with conventional medical treatment, such as selected mind-body practices or acupuncture; it is distinct from alternative medicine, which replaces conventional care.

### **Complementary Sequence**

A nucleic-acid sequence whose bases pair with another sequence according to pairing rules, allowing hybridization between DNA or RNA strands.

### **Compound Heterozygote**

A person who has two different pathogenic variants in the two copies of the same gene, one inherited on each homologous chromosome.

### **Compress**

To press together or apply pressure, as with a bandage or device, or to reduce the volume of something.

### **Compression**

Pressure applied to tissue or a structure, which may reduce swelling or bleeding but can also impair nerves, blood vessels, or organs when excessive.



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### **Computerized Axial Tomography (CAT)**

Computed tomography, an imaging method that uses X-rays and computer processing to produce cross-sectional images of the body; it is also called a CT or CAT scan.

### **Conditioning**

Learning in which repeated association or reinforcement changes a behavior or response; in medicine, conditioning can also mean preparing a patient or tissue for a treatment.

### **Condom**

A thin barrier sheath worn on the penis or inserted into the vagina that helps prevent pregnancy and reduces transmission of sexually transmitted infections when used correctly.

### **Condyloma**

A wart-like growth, often in the genital or anal area and commonly caused by human papillomavirus; condyloma lata are lesions of secondary syphilis.

### **Conformal Radiation Therapy**

Radiation treatment planned so that the high-dose region conforms closely to the tumor's three-dimensional shape while limiting exposure of nearby normal tissue.

### **Congenital**

Present at birth, whether inherited, caused by a developmental problem, or acquired before birth.

### **Congenital Malformation**

A structural abnormality that develops before birth and is present at birth, caused by genetic, environmental, developmental, or unknown factors.

### **Conjunctival**

Relating to the conjunctiva, the thin mucous membrane covering the front of the eye and lining the inner eyelids.

### **Consanguinity**

A biological relationship between people who share a

recent common ancestor; it can increase the chance that both parents carry the same recessive disease variant.

### **Consumption**

An older term for tuberculosis, especially wasting pulmonary tuberculosis; in general usage it also means the act or amount of using something.

### **Contraceptive Device, Intrauterine (IUD)**

A small device placed inside the uterus to prevent pregnancy; copper IUDs impair sperm function, while hormonal IUDs release levonorgestrel and thicken cervical mucus.

### **Contraceptive, Pill**

An oral hormonal contraceptive, usually a combined estrogen–progestin pill or a progestin-only pill, that prevents ovulation and/or changes cervical mucus and the uterine lining.

### **Contraction**

Shortening or tightening of a muscle; uterine contractions during labor thin and dilate the cervix and help deliver the fetus.

### **Contrast**

A difference that makes structures distinguishable; in imaging, contrast material is administered to improve visualization of organs, vessels, or tissues.

### **Control (Research)**

A comparison participant or group in a study that does not receive the experimental intervention, or receives standard care or a placebo, allowing the intervention's effects to be estimated.

### **Coprolalia**

Involuntary utterance of obscene, taboo, or socially inappropriate words, most often described as a complex vocal tic in Tourette syndrome.

### **Coprophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of feces or defecation.

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## CoQ10

Coenzyme Q10, a lipid-soluble mitochondrial electron-transport compound and antioxidant also sold as a dietary supplement.

## Cor

The Latin anatomical term for heart, used in medical names such as cor pulmonale.

## Cord

A long, narrow structure such as the spinal cord, which contains the central nervous tissue, or the umbilical cord, which connects a fetus to the placenta.

## Coronal

Relating to a plane that divides the body into front and back portions, or to the crown or top of a structure.

## Corporeal

Relating to the physical body rather than the mind or spirit.

## Corpus

Latin for body; in anatomy it refers to the main body of an organ or structure, such as the corpus callosum or corpus uteri.

## Cortical

Relating to the cortex, the outer layer of an organ such as the brain, kidney, or adrenal gland.

## Corticosteroid

A steroid hormone from the adrenal cortex or a synthetic analogue; glucocorticoids reduce inflammation and immune activity, while mineralocorticoids regulate salt and water balance.

## Cortisone

A corticosteroid that is converted in the body to cortisol and can be used to reduce inflammation or replace glucocorticoid activity.

## Cosmeceutical

A cosmetic product marketed as having biologically active, drug-like benefits; the term has no uniform formal regulatory category in many jurisdictions.

## Cough Suppressant

An antitussive medicine or measure that reduces the urge or reflex to cough; treatment should address the underlying cause and avoid suppressing a productive cough when clearance is needed.

## Counterpulsation

Timed inflation and deflation of a balloon or external cuffs in relation to the heartbeat to improve coronary perfusion or reduce cardiac workload, as in intra-aortic balloon counterpulsation.

## Cox-1 Inhibitor

A drug that inhibits cyclooxygenase-1 and reduces production of prostaglandins and thromboxanes; inhibition can contribute to analgesia but also gastrointestinal, renal, and platelet effects.

## Cox-2

Cyclooxygenase-2, an inducible enzyme that produces inflammatory prostaglandins; selective COX-2 inhibitors reduce pain and inflammation but may have cardiovascular, renal, and gastrointestinal risks.

## CpG

A DNA sequence in which cytosine is followed by guanine on the same strand, often occurring in regions whose methylation helps regulate gene expression.

## Crack (Drug)

A smokable, rapidly acting form of cocaine; it can cause dependence, severe cardiovascular effects, seizures, stroke, psychiatric symptoms, and overdose.

## Cramping Leg Pain

Pain caused by involuntary, often painful muscle contraction in the leg; contributors include exertion,

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dehydration, electrolyte abnormalities, medications, nerve disease, and impaired circulation.

### **Cranial**

Relating to the skull or toward the head, as opposed to caudal or toward the lower end of the body.

### **Cranial Nerve X**

The vagus nerve, the tenth cranial nerve, which carries parasympathetic and sensory fibers and contributes to swallowing, voice, and regulation of thoracic and abdominal organs.

### **Cranial Nerves**

The 12 pairs of nerves arising from the brain or brainstem that provide sensory, motor, and autonomic functions to the head, neck, and parts of the trunk.

### **Cranio-**

A combining form meaning skull or cranium.

### **Cranium**

The part of the skull that encloses and protects the brain, consisting of the cranial bones and their joints.

### **Crapulence**

An unpleasant state of sickness or discomfort caused by excessive eating or drinking, especially excessive alcohol use.

### **CRC**

Colorectal cancer, malignant disease arising in the colon or rectum; screening and evaluation depend on age, risk, symptoms, and test results.

### **Crime Scene Investigation**

The systematic documentation, collection, preservation, and analysis of physical evidence from a suspected crime scene, often supporting forensic medical and legal conclusions.

### **Crocodile Tears Syndrome**

Gustatory lacrimation, in which eating or smelling

food triggers excessive tearing, usually after facial-nerve injury or aberrant regeneration following Bell palsy.

### **Cross-Section**

A slice or plane made through a structure, or an image showing that slice, such as a cross-sectional CT image.

### **Crotch**

The region where the inner thighs meet the trunk, including the groin and nearby perineal structures.

### **Cry For Help**

A verbal or behavioral expression of distress or need for assistance; in a mental-health setting it should be taken seriously and assessed for immediate safety concerns.

### **Cryophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of cold, freezing temperatures, or cold objects.

### **Cryostat**

An instrument that maintains very low temperatures and cuts thin frozen sections of tissue for rapid microscopic examination.

### **Crypt**

A small cavity, gland, or recess, such as an intestinal crypt or tonsillar crypt.

### **Crypto**

Clinical shorthand that may refer to cryptococcosis or *Cryptosporidium* infection; the intended meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **CSF (Cerebrospinal Fluid)**

A clear fluid produced within the brain that surrounds and cushions the brain and spinal cord, helps regulate their chemical environment, and can be examined for disease.

### **CTL**

Cytotoxic T lymphocyte, an immune cell that rec-

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ognizes and kills infected, abnormal, or target cells through antigen-specific mechanisms.

### **CTS**

Commonly, carpal tunnel syndrome: compression of the median nerve at the wrist causing numbness, tingling, pain, or weakness in the hand.

### **Cubital**

Relating to the elbow or the forearm, especially the area around the elbow.

### **Cubitus**

The elbow or the forearm; the term is also used in names of structures and conditions around the elbow.

### **Cul-De-Sac**

A blind-ending pouch or recess; in pelvic anatomy, the rectouterine pouch and rectovesical pouch are examples.

### **Cure**

Elimination or durable control of a disease so that it no longer causes active illness; the meaning and evidence for cure vary by condition.

### **Cushingoid**

Resembling the physical features of excess glucocorticoid exposure, such as a round face, central weight gain, thin skin, easy bruising, and muscle weakness.

### **Cusp**

A pointed projection, such as a projection of a tooth or one of the leaflets of a heart valve.

### **Cut**

A break or incision made in tissue, usually by a sharp object; the depth, contamination, and location determine the required care.

### **Cutaneous**

Relating to or affecting the skin.

### **Cutis Anserina**

Gooseflesh or piloerection, in which contraction of tiny muscles around hair follicles makes the skin appear rough or dimpled.

### **Cutting For The Stone**

An older term for surgically opening the urinary tract to remove a stone, historically called lithotomy.

### **CVC**

Central venous catheter, a catheter whose tip lies in a large central vein and provides intravenous access for medications, fluids, nutrition, or monitoring.

### **CVS**

An abbreviation that may mean cardiovascular system or chorionic-villus sampling, a prenatal diagnostic procedure; context determines the meaning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome (CVS)

### **Cyanide**

A highly toxic chemical ion or compound that inhibits cellular cytochrome oxidase, preventing tissues from using oxygen and potentially causing rapid fatal poisoning.

### **Cyanotic**

Having a bluish or slate-gray discoloration of skin or mucous membranes, usually reflecting increased deoxygenated hemoglobin or abnormal blood flow.

### **Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide**

A laboratory antigen used to detect anti-CCP antibodies, which are highly specific for rheumatoid arthritis but are interpreted with clinical findings.

### **Cyclooxygenase-2**

An inducible cyclooxygenase enzyme that generates prostaglandins involved in inflammation, pain, and fever and is inhibited by COX-2-selective medicines.

### **Cyclops**

A term that may refer to cyclopia, a rare severe congenital malformation with a single central eye,

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or to a fibrous nodule causing loss of extension after knee surgery; context determines the meaning.

### **Cysts**

Closed sac-like structures containing fluid, air, semisolid material, or other contents; their causes range from benign developmental or obstructive processes to infection or neoplasia.

### **Cyte**

A suffix meaning cell, as in erythrocyte or leukocyte.

### **Cyto-**

A combining form meaning cell.

### **Cytoplasm**

The material inside a cell between the cell membrane and nucleus, consisting of cytosol, organelles, and other cellular components.

### **Cytosis**

A suffix or term indicating a condition involving cells or, in some contexts, an increase in the number of a particular type of cell.

### **Cytotoxic**

Toxic to cells or capable of killing cells, as with some chemotherapy drugs, toxins, or cytotoxic immune cells.

### **Childhood Schizophrenia**

A rare psychotic disorder beginning in childhood, involving disturbances in thinking, perception, behavior, and emotional functioning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Juvenile Schizophrenia Schizophrenia, Adolescent Schizophrenia, Childhood Schizophrenia, Juvenile

### **Childhood Asthma**

Asthma beginning during childhood, involving variable airway narrowing and inflammation that cause wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or shortness of breath.

### **Chigger Bites**

Itchy inflammatory skin reactions caused by the larvae of trombiculid mites. Small red bumps or blisters often occur around areas where clothing fits tightly and may itch intensely for several days. Washing the skin and clothing, topical antipruritics, and avoiding scratching can help; persistent or infected lesions require assessment.

### **Cholangiocarcinoma (Bile Duct Cancer)**

Cancer arising in the bile ducts, which may cause jaundice, itching, abdominal discomfort, weight loss, or impaired bile flow.

### **Cyclospora Infection**

An intestinal infection caused by the parasite *Cyclospora cayetanensis*, usually acquired from contaminated food or water. It commonly causes prolonged watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, fatigue, and weight loss. Diagnosis requires specialized stool testing, and antimicrobial treatment is often effective.

### **Congenital Penile Curvature**

Curvature of the penis present from birth, usually caused by unequal development of the erectile tissues. Mild curvature may need no treatment; significant curvature causing functional difficulty may require specialist assessment.

### **Common Warts (Verruca Vulgaris)**

Benign, rough-surfaced skin growths caused by infection with human papillomavirus (HPV), commonly affecting the hands and fingers.

#### **Synonyms:**

Verruca Vulgaris

### **C And T Cells**

B cells produce antibodies, while T cells coordinate cellular immunity or destroy infected and abnormal cells; together they form major lymphocyte populations.

### **C-Reactive Protein (CRP)**

C-reactive protein is a liver-produced acute-phase

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protein that rises with inflammation or infection but does not by itself identify the cause.

### **Caesarean Section**

A caesarean section is surgical delivery of a baby through incisions in the abdomen and uterus when vaginal birth is unsafe or not feasible.

### **Calamine**

Calamine is a topical preparation containing zinc compounds used to soothe itching and irritation from minor rashes, insect bites, and sunburn.

### **Calcaneum**

The calcaneum, or calcaneus, is the large heel bone that transfers load from the ankle and forms part of the hindfoot.

### **Calculus**

A calculus is a hard deposit formed from mineral salts, such as a kidney stone, gallstone, or dental tartar.

### **Callosal**

Callosal means relating to the corpus callosum, the major bundle of fibers connecting the cerebral hemispheres.

### **Callosity**

A callosity is a localized area of thickened skin caused by repeated pressure or friction.

### **Calprotectin**

Calprotectin is a protein released by activated neutrophils; fecal calprotectin helps detect intestinal inflammation, especially in inflammatory bowel disease.

### **Canaliculus**

A canaliculus is a small anatomical channel, such as a lacrimal canaliculus that drains tears from the eyelid into the lacrimal sac.

### **Canalization**

Canalization is formation or restoration of a channel

through tissue, a vessel, or an embryonic structure; in thrombosis it may describe reopening of an occluded vessel.

### **Canine Teeth**

Canine teeth are pointed teeth between the incisors and premolars that tear food and help guide jaw movement.

### **Canker**

Canker is a nontechnical term often referring to an aphthous mouth ulcer, a painful shallow ulcer of the oral mucosa.

### **Cannabis**

Cannabis is a plant containing cannabinoids such as THC and CBD; effects include altered perception, impaired coordination, therapeutic actions, and possible dependence or adverse effects.

### **Cantharides**

Cantharides are preparations made from blister beetles containing cantharidin, a potent irritant that can cause severe poisoning and urinary or gastrointestinal injury.

### **Capillary Microscope**

A capillary microscope magnifies small blood vessels, especially nail-fold capillaries, to assess structure and abnormalities in microcirculation.

### **Capitation**

Capitation is a healthcare payment arrangement in which a provider receives a fixed amount per enrolled person for defined services over a period.

### **Caplan's Syndrome**

Caplan's syndrome is pneumoconiosis with rheumatoid arthritis, producing lung nodules in people exposed to mineral or coal dust.

### **Captopril Renal Scan**

A captopril renal scan uses a radiotracer before and after captopril to assess renovascular hypertension by detecting impaired renal perfusion or function.



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## **Carbamide**

Carbamide is urea, a nitrogen-containing compound produced by protein metabolism and excreted by the kidneys; it is also used in some topical preparations.

## **Carbimazole**

Carbimazole is an antithyroid drug converted to methimazole that reduces thyroid-hormone synthesis; rare serious adverse effects include agranulocytosis and liver injury.

## **Carboxyhaemoglobin**

Carboxyhaemoglobin is hemoglobin bound to carbon monoxide, reducing oxygen carriage and release; elevated levels indicate carbon-monoxide exposure.

## **Carcinoembryonic Antigen (CEA)**

CEA is a tumor-associated glycoprotein used mainly to monitor selected cancers, especially colorectal cancer; it is not sufficiently specific for screening alone.

## **Carcinoid**

A carcinoid is a usually slow-growing neuroendocrine tumor that may release hormones such as serotonin and occur in the gastrointestinal tract, appendix, or lungs.

## **Cardiac Failure**

Cardiac failure, or heart failure, is inability of the heart to pump or fill adequately, causing breathlessness, fatigue, fluid retention, or reduced organ perfusion.

## **Cardiac Massage**

Cardiac massage is manual compression of the heart, historically performed through the chest or during open surgery; modern cardiac arrest care uses chest compressions and advanced resuscitation.

## **Cardiac Pacemaker**

A cardiac pacemaker is an implanted or external device that delivers electrical impulses to maintain an adequate heart rate when intrinsic conduction is too slow or unreliable.

## **Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (CPR)**

CPR combines chest compressions and rescue breaths or assisted ventilation to maintain circulation and oxygenation during cardiac arrest.

## **Cardiorespiratory**

Cardiorespiratory means relating to the heart, blood vessels, and respiratory system considered together, as in cardiorespiratory fitness or failure.

## **Carpus**

The carpus is the group of eight wrist bones connecting the forearm to the metacarpals.

## **Caruncles**

Caruncles are small fleshy anatomical projections, such as the lacrimal caruncle at the inner corner of the eye or urethral caruncle.

## **Cascara**

Cascara is a plant-derived stimulant laxative containing anthraquinones; prolonged or excessive use can cause diarrhea, electrolyte imbalance, and dependence.

## **Catatonia, Fatal**

Fatal catatonia is a severe, life-threatening catatonic state with marked motor and behavioral disturbance, fever, autonomic instability, and risk of organ failure.

## **Catbite**

A catbite is a puncture wound caused by a cat, with a high risk of bacterial infection, including *Pasteurella*, and possible tendon, joint, or bone involvement.

## **Cat-Bite Fever**

Cat-bite fever is an informal term for illness after a cat bite or scratch; possible causes include bacterial wound infection and cat-scratch disease.

## **Catecholamines**

Catecholamines include adrenaline, noradrenaline, and dopamine, hormones and neurotransmitters

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involved in stress responses, blood pressure, heart function, and metabolism.

### **Caterpillar Dermatitis**

Caterpillar dermatitis is an itchy inflammatory skin reaction caused by contact with irritating or venomous caterpillar hairs or spines.

### **Catharsis**

Catharsis is emotional release or expression; it is a historical psychological concept and not a specific medical treatment or diagnosis.

### **Cat-Nap**

A cat-nap is a short period of sleep, usually during the day; frequent unintended sleep may warrant assessment for sleep deprivation or a sleep disorder.

### **Cat's Eye Reflex**

The cat's-eye reflex is a bright whitish reflection from the pupil, called leukocoria in humans, which can signal serious eye disease and requires urgent assessment.

### **Caustic**

Caustic describes a substance that chemically burns or destroys tissue, such as a strong acid or alkali; ingestion or contact can be a medical emergency.

### **Cautery**

Cautery destroys or seals tissue using heat, electricity, chemicals, or another energy source to control bleeding or remove abnormal tissue.

### **Cavernous Sinus**

The cavernous sinus is a venous channel beside the pituitary and sphenoid bone containing important cranial nerves and the internal carotid artery; thrombosis or infection can be life-threatening.

### **Cavum**

Cavum means a cavity or hollow space, such as the cavum septi pellucidi in the brain; the specific anatomical meaning depends on the term.

### **Cea**

CEA is an abbreviation for carcinoembryonic antigen, a tumor marker used mainly to monitor selected cancers.

### **Cellophane**

Cellophane is a thin transparent cellulose film; in medicine it may be used in dressings, packaging, or specialized laboratory techniques.

### **Cement**

Medical cement, especially bone cement, is a material used to fix prostheses or fill spaces; other cements may be dental or industrial and require context.

### **Cenesthesia**

Cenesthesia is the general sense of the condition and position of one's body; disturbance may occur in neurologic or psychiatric illness.

### **Center**

In anatomy or clinical measurement, a center is a central point, region, or facility organized around a function; the specific meaning depends on context.

### **Centrum**

Centrum means a central part, especially the main body of a vertebra around which the neural arch develops.

### **Cephalosporins**

Cephalosporins are beta-lactam antibiotics that inhibit bacterial cell-wall synthesis; generations differ in spectrum, and allergy, diarrhea, and resistance are important considerations.

### **Cercaria**

A cercaria is a free-swimming larval stage of a trematode parasite; contact with some species can cause swimmer's itch or other infection.

### **Cerebellar**

Cerebellar means relating to the cerebellum, which coordinates balance, posture, eye movements, and

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skilled movement.

### **Cerebral Diplegia**

Cerebral diplegia is a form of cerebral palsy with predominant weakness and spasticity of both legs, often greater than in the arms.

### **Cerebral Haemorrhage**

Cerebral haemorrhage is bleeding within brain tissue or an adjacent intracranial space, causing pressure, tissue injury, and neurologic deficits.

### **Cerebral Tumours**

Cerebral tumours are abnormal growths in the cerebrum, which may be benign or malignant and cause seizures, headache, cognitive change, or focal deficits.

### **Cerebrospinal Fluid (CSF)**

Cerebrospinal fluid is clear fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord that cushions the nervous system and supports chemical transport and waste clearance.

### **Cerebrovascular Accident (CVA)**

A cerebrovascular accident is a stroke caused by interrupted brain blood flow from ischemia or bleeding, producing sudden neurologic dysfunction.

### **Cervical Biopsy**

A cervical biopsy removes a small sample of cervix for microscopic examination, commonly to investigate abnormal screening or suspected precancer or cancer.

### **Cervical Cap**

A cervical cap is a flexible barrier placed over the cervix to reduce sperm entry; it is used with spermicide as a contraceptive method.

### **Cervix Uteri**

The cervix uteri is the lower portion of the uterus that projects into the vagina and forms the passage between the uterus and birth canal.

### **Cestode**

A cestode is a tapeworm, a segmented parasitic flatworm that can infect humans or animals through contaminated food, water, or intermediate hosts.

### **Cetrimide**

Cetrimide is a quaternary ammonium antiseptic and detergent used in some topical or laboratory preparations; concentrated exposure irritates tissue.

### **Charcot's Joints**

Charcot's joints are severely damaged, unstable joints caused by loss of protective sensation, classically in diabetic neuropathy or other neurologic disease.

### **Charcot's Triad**

Charcot's triad is fever, jaundice, and right-upper-quadrant pain, a classic but incomplete clinical pattern of acute ascending cholangitis.

### **Chaulmoogra Oil**

Chaulmoogra oil is a historical plant oil once used to treat leprosy and some skin diseases; it has largely been replaced by effective antimicrobial therapy.

### **Check-Up**

A check-up is a routine health evaluation used to review symptoms, risk factors, preventive care, examination findings, and appropriate screening.

### **Chelating Agents**

Chelating agents bind specific metal ions to form complexes that can facilitate their removal or reduce toxicity; examples include agents for lead, iron, or copper poisoning.

### **Chemoattractant**

A chemoattractant is a chemical signal that guides cells, especially immune cells, toward a source of the signal during inflammation or development.

### **Chemoreceptors**

Chemoreceptors detect chemical changes such as oxygen, carbon dioxide, pH, or odor molecules and

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trigger neural or physiologic responses.

### **Chemosurgery**

Chemosurgery uses a chemical agent to destroy selected abnormal tissue, historically including chemical treatment of skin lesions; modern use is specialized.

### **Child Adoption**

Child adoption is the legal process by which parental rights and caregiving responsibility are transferred to adoptive parents; medical care includes records, consent, and family history.

### **Child Guidance**

Child guidance provides assessment and support for children's emotional, behavioral, developmental, and family difficulties.

### **Child Health Services**

Child health services provide preventive care, immunization, growth and developmental monitoring, screening, treatment, and support for children and families.

### **Chill**

A chill is a sensation of cold, often with shivering, that can accompany fever, infection, exposure, anxiety, or other illness.

### **Chiropody**

Chiropody is care of the feet, including assessment and treatment of skin, nail, pressure, and biomechanical problems; it is also called podiatry.

### **Chlorinated Lime**

Chlorinated lime, or bleaching powder, releases chlorine and is used as a disinfectant; concentrated exposure can burn skin, eyes, and airways.

### **Chlormethine**

Chlormethine, or mechlorethamine, is an alkylating anticancer drug used systemically or topically for selected cancers and cutaneous T-cell lymphoma.

### **Chlortalidone**

Chlortalidone, also called chlorthalidone, is a long-acting thiazide-like diuretic used mainly for hypertension and fluid retention.

### **Chocolate Cyst**

A chocolate cyst is an ovarian endometrioma filled with old blood from endometriosis, which can cause pelvic pain, infertility, or an adnexal mass.

### **Choleresis**

Choleresis is production and secretion of bile by liver cells.

### **Cholestyramine**

Cholestyramine is a bile-acid sequestrant used to lower LDL cholesterol and sometimes to treat bile-acid diarrhea or itching from cholestasis.

### **Choline**

Choline is an essential nutrient used to make cell membranes and acetylcholine and to support liver and nervous-system function.

### **Cholinergic**

Cholinergic means related to acetylcholine or receptors and pathways activated by it, including muscarinic and nicotinic signaling.

### **Cholinesterase**

Cholinesterase enzymes break down acetylcholine; inhibition increases cholinergic activity and is used therapeutically but can also cause poisoning.

### **Chondroblastoma**

A chondroblastoma is an uncommon usually benign cartilage-forming bone tumor, often arising near the end of a long bone in adolescents or young adults.

### **Chordee**

Chordee is abnormal downward or other curvature of the penis, commonly associated with hypospadias or scar tissue and sometimes requiring surgical correction.

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### Choreoathetosis

Choreoathetosis combines irregular, dance-like chorea with slow twisting athetotic movements and may result from basal-ganglia injury or genetic disease.

### Chorion Villus Sampling (CVS)

Chorion villus sampling removes placental tissue for genetic or chromosomal testing, usually early in pregnancy; it carries a small procedure-related miscarriage risk.

### Chorionic Gonadotrophin

Chorionic gonadotrophin, especially hCG, is a placental hormone that maintains early pregnancy and is measured in pregnancy tests and selected tumor evaluations.

### Choroiditis

Choroiditis is inflammation of the choroid, the vascular layer behind the retina, often causing blurred vision, floaters, or visual-field disturbance.

### Choroideremia

Choroideremia is an X-linked inherited retinal degeneration causing progressive night blindness and loss of peripheral then central vision, mainly in males.

### Chromaffin

Chromaffin describes cells that stain with chromium salts because they contain catecholamine-rich granules, especially adrenal medullary cells and related neuroendocrine cells.

### Chromate

Chromate is a hexavalent chromium compound that can cause irritant or allergic dermatitis, nasal injury, respiratory disease, and cancer after occupational exposure.

### Chromatic

Chromatic means relating to color or wavelengths of light; chromatic vision depends on cone photoreceptors and neural processing.

### Chromatids

Chromatids are the two copies of a replicated chromosome joined at the centromere before separating during cell division.

### Chromium

Chromium is a metallic element; trivalent chromium is a trace nutrient, while hexavalent compounds can be toxic, corrosive, mutagenic, and carcinogenic.

### Chronic Fatigue Syndrome (CFS)

Chronic fatigue syndrome, also called myalgic encephalomyelitis, involves substantial persistent fatigue with post-exertional worsening, unrefreshing sleep, and cognitive or orthostatic symptoms.

### Chronobiology

Chronobiology studies biological timing and rhythms, including circadian sleep-wake cycles, seasonal rhythms, and their effects on health.

### Chronotropic

Chronotropic describes an influence on heart rate; a positive chronotropic effect increases rate, while a negative effect decreases it.

### Chrysarobin

Chrysarobin is a plant-derived anthracene compound formerly used topically for psoriasis and other skin disorders; it can irritate and stain skin.

### Chvostek's Sign

Chvostek's sign is twitching of facial muscles after tapping near the facial nerve, sometimes associated with hypocalcemia but neither sensitive nor specific.

### Chymotrypsin

Chymotrypsin is a pancreatic digestive enzyme that cleaves proteins in the small intestine; abnormal pancreatic release can contribute to tissue injury.

### Cicatrization

Cicatrization is healing by formation of a scar after tissue injury, with replacement of damaged tissue by fibrous connective tissue.

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### Cidofovir

Cidofovir is an antiviral nucleotide analogue used for selected serious DNA-virus infections; kidney toxicity requires careful dosing and monitoring.

### Cimetidine

Cimetidine is an H<sub>2</sub>-receptor antagonist that reduces gastric acid secretion; it has numerous drug interactions and is used less often than newer agents.

### Cinnarizine

Cinnarizine is an antihistamine with calcium-channel-blocking properties used in some countries for motion sickness and vestibular symptoms.

### Ciprofloxacin

Ciprofloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections; tendon injury, nerve effects, QT effects, and resistance limit indiscriminate use.

### Circumvallate Papillae

Circumvallate papillae are large taste papillae arranged near the back of the tongue and surrounded by a trench containing taste buds and serous glands.

### Citalopram

Citalopram is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor used to treat depression and some anxiety disorders; nausea, sexual effects, and QT prolongation are important considerations.

### Citrate

Citrate is a salt or ion of citric acid that participates in metabolism and binds calcium; it is used in anticoagulant blood collection and some stone-prevention treatments.

### Citric Acid Cycle

The citric acid cycle is a mitochondrial pathway that oxidizes acetyl-CoA and generates reducing equivalents for ATP production.

### Citrullinaemia

Citrullinaemia is an inherited urea-cycle disorder

causing accumulation of citrulline and potentially life-threatening hyperammonemia.

### Cladribine

Cladribine is a purine analogue used for selected blood cancers and multiple sclerosis; lymphocyte depletion and infection risk require monitoring.

### Clairvoyance

Clairvoyance is an alleged ability to perceive information beyond ordinary sensory means; it is not an established medical diagnostic finding.

### Clang Association

Clang association is speech in which word choice is driven by sound, rhyme, or pun rather than meaning, seen particularly in mania or psychosis.

### Clarithromycin

Clarithromycin is a macrolide antibiotic used for selected bacterial and mycobacterial infections; interactions and QT prolongation are important risks.

### Clavus

A clavus is a localized painful thickening of skin, or corn, caused by repeated pressure or friction.

### Clear Cell Carcinoma

Clear cell carcinoma is a cancer whose cells appear clear because of glycogen or lipid; it can arise in organs such as kidney, ovary, or endometrium.

### Clemastine

Clemastine is a first-generation antihistamine used for allergic symptoms; sedation, anticholinergic effects, and impaired driving are concerns.

### Clendamyacin

Clendamyacin is a misspelling of clindamycin, a lincosamide antibiotic that inhibits bacterial protein synthesis and can cause severe antibiotic-associated colitis.

### Climate

Climate is the long-term pattern of weather and envi-



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ronmental conditions; climate affects infectious disease, heat illness, allergies, and population health.

### **Clindamycin**

Clindamycin is a lincosamide antibiotic used for selected infections; diarrhea and *Clostridioides difficile* colitis are important adverse effects.

### **Clinically Proven**

Clinically proven means supported by clinical evidence, but the strength, quality, population, and outcome of that evidence must be specified.

### **Clinistix**

Clinistix is a reagent-strip method historically used to detect glucose in urine through an enzymatic color reaction.

### **Clinitest**

Clinitest is a tablet-based copper-reduction test historically used to detect reducing substances in urine, including glucose; it is less specific than modern methods.

### **Clitoromegaly**

Clitoromegaly is enlargement of the clitoris, which may be congenital or acquired from androgen excess, endocrine disease, medication, or other causes.

### **Clodronate**

Clodronate is a bisphosphonate that reduces bone resorption and is used in selected bone and cancer-related conditions.

### **Clofazimine**

Clofazimine is a riminophenazine antimicrobial used mainly in multidrug treatment of leprosy and selected mycobacterial infections; skin discoloration is common.

### **Clomifene**

Clomifene, or clomiphene, is a selective estrogen-receptor modulator used to induce ovulation in selected infertility settings.

### **Clomipramine**

Clomipramine is a tricyclic antidepressant particularly effective for obsessive-compulsive disorder; anticholinergic, cardiac, and overdose toxicity are important.

### **Clonazepam**

Clonazepam is a benzodiazepine anticonvulsant and anxiolytic that enhances GABA activity; sedation, dependence, and respiratory depression can occur.

### **Clonidine**

Clonidine stimulates central alpha-2 receptors to reduce sympathetic outflow and is used for hypertension and selected other conditions; abrupt withdrawal can cause rebound hypertension.

### **Clopidogrel**

Clopidogrel is an antiplatelet drug that irreversibly blocks the platelet P2Y<sub>12</sub> receptor, reducing arterial thrombosis risk after selected cardiovascular events or procedures.

### **Closure**

Closure is the joining or sealing of a wound, opening, vessel, duct, or anatomical structure, either naturally or by treatment.

### **Clot**

A clot is a semisolid mass of coagulated blood; clots may stop bleeding or obstruct a vessel and cause thrombosis or embolism.

### **Clotrimazole**

Clotrimazole is an azole antifungal used topically or orally in selected formulations for fungal infections of skin, mouth, or vagina.

### **Clove Oil**

Clove oil contains eugenol and is used in some dental and topical products; concentrated ingestion or exposure can cause irritation, liver injury, or seizures.

### **Clozapine**

Clozapine is an atypical antipsychotic for treatment-

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resistant schizophrenia and selected suicidality risk; neutropenia, myocarditis, seizures, constipation, and metabolic effects require monitoring.

### Clumping

Clumping is aggregation of cells, particles, or proteins into visible groups, as in red-cell agglutination or platelet aggregation.

### Clysis

Clysis is administration of fluid into the rectum, historically used for hydration, medication, or bowel treatment; modern use is limited.

### Coagulation Defects

Coagulation defects are abnormalities of clotting proteins, platelets, vessels, or regulation that cause excessive bleeding or inappropriate thrombosis.

### Coagulation Time

Coagulation time is the time required for a blood sample to form a clot under specified test conditions; modern tests usually measure particular pathways more precisely.

### Cobalt

Cobalt is a metal present in vitamin B12 and some industrial materials; excess exposure can injure the heart, thyroid, lungs, or skin.

### Coccarboxylase

Coccarboxylase is thiamine pyrophosphate, the active coenzyme form of vitamin B1 required for several oxidative carbohydrate and amino-acid reactions.

### Cardiac Enzymes

Historically used blood markers of myocardial injury, especially creatine kinase-MB; cardiac troponins are now the preferred biomarkers for detecting myocardial injury and must be interpreted with symptoms, ECG findings, and serial changes.

### Coronary Artery Anomaly

A congenital abnormality in the origin, course, struc-

ture, or termination of a coronary artery. Some anomalies are incidental, whereas others can impair myocardial perfusion or increase the risk of ischemia, arrhythmia, or sudden cardiac death.

### Cardiac Syncope

Transient loss of consciousness caused by a cardiac disorder that reduces cerebral perfusion, usually through bradyarrhythmia, tachyarrhythmia, structural obstruction, or severe cardiac dysfunction. Syncope during exertion, while supine, or with palpitations or known heart disease requires urgent cardiovascular evaluation because it may indicate a risk of sudden cardiac death.

### Coronary Microvascular Angina

Angina caused by impaired regulation or constriction of the small coronary vessels, often producing ischemic symptoms despite no flow-limiting epicardial coronary obstruction. Assessment may include evaluation for coronary microvascular dysfunction; management is individualized according to symptoms, cardiovascular risk, and the underlying mechanism.

### Crust

Dried serum, blood, pus, or other exudate on the skin surface, often covering an erosion, ulcer, vesicle, pustule, or inflamed lesion.

### Circadian Rhythms

Approximately 24-hour biological cycles that regulate sleep and wakefulness, hormone release, body temperature, metabolism, and other physiological functions in response chiefly to light and darkness.

### Coagulation Factor

A blood protein required for the coagulation cascade and formation of a stable fibrin clot; deficiencies or inhibitors can cause bleeding, while excessive activation can contribute to thrombosis.

### Cell-Mediated Immune Response

Alternate index label; see *Cell-mediated immunity*.

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## Contraindications

Alternate index label; see *Contraindication*.

## Connective Tissue Disease-Related Interstitial Lung Disease

Interstitial lung disease associated with autoimmune connective-tissue disease such as systemic sclerosis, rheumatoid arthritis, polymyositis, dermatomyositis, or Sjogren syndrome; inflammation and fibrosis can impair gas exchange.

## Antinuclear Antibodies

Alternate index label; see *Antinuclear Antibody*.

## Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition

Alternate index label; see *Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition Disease*.

## Chronic Recurrent Multifocal Osteomyelitis

A rare autoinflammatory bone disorder, often beginning in children or adolescents, causing recurrent sterile inflammation and pain at multiple bone sites; it is also called CRMO.

## Cryopyrin-Associated Autoinflammatory Syndromes

Alternate index label; see *Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndromes*; the group is also called CAPS.

## Cholinergic Toxidrome

A poisoning pattern caused by excessive acetylcholine activity, often producing salivation, tearing, urination, diarrhea, vomiting, bronchial secretions, slow heart rate, muscle fasciculations, weakness, or respiratory failure.

## Carrier Screening

Genetic testing offered to people without symptoms to determine whether they carry a pathogenic variant for a recessive or X-linked condition that could be passed to a child.

## Chromosomal Microarray

A genetic test that detects gains and losses of chro-

sosome material, including copy-number variants and some regions of homozygosity; it is commonly used for developmental delay, intellectual disability, congenital anomalies, or autism-spectrum presentations.

## Copy Number Variant

A deletion or duplication that changes the number of copies of a DNA segment; its clinical significance depends on the region, size, genes involved, inheritance, and available evidence.

## Carcinoma Erysipeloides

Cutaneous lymphatic spread of an internal carcinoma producing a sharply demarcated, erythematous, indurated plaque that may resemble erysipelas.

## Cylindroma

A usually benign adnexal tumor composed of basoid cells, often presenting as a firm pink or skin-coloured nodule on the scalp or face; multiple lesions may occur in Brooke-Spiegler syndrome.

## Cutaneous Angiosarcoma

An aggressive malignant vascular tumor of skin, typically affecting the scalp and face of older adults as a bruise-like or violaceous plaque that may ulcerate or metastasize.

## Cutaneous Metastasis

A deposit of malignant cells in the skin from a primary tumor elsewhere or, less often, another cutaneous site; it may present as a firm nodule, plaque, or inflammatory-appearing lesion.

## Adenocarcinoma In Situ Of Cervix

A noninvasive glandular precursor lesion of the cervix, usually associated with high-risk human papillomavirus; abnormal glandular cells remain confined to the epithelium but may progress to invasive adenocarcinoma.

## Adenoma Malignum

A rare, deceptively bland, deeply infiltrative gastric-type adenocarcinoma of the cervix with minimal

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cytologic atypia; persistent watery discharge may occur and diagnosis requires expert histopathology.

### **Adenoid Basal Carcinoma**

A rare, usually indolent cervical carcinoma composed of small basaloid nests, often associated with squamous intraepithelial lesions and requiring distinction from more aggressive tumors.

### **Cervical Adenocarcinoma**

A malignant gland-forming tumor arising in the uterine cervix; it may be HPV-associated or HPV-independent and commonly presents with abnormal bleeding or discharge.

### **Cervical Squamous Cell Carcinoma**

A malignant squamous tumor of the cervix, most often caused by persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection; it may present with abnormal bleeding, discharge, or an abnormal screening result.

### **Cervical Polyp**

A usually benign polypoid overgrowth of endocervical or ectocervical tissue that may cause intermenstrual or postcoital bleeding or may be found incidentally during examination.

### **Glassy Cell Carcinoma**

A rare poorly differentiated adenosquamous carcinoma of the cervix with distinctive glassy cytoplasm, prominent nucleoli, and aggressive clinical behavior.

### **Mesonephric Adenocarcinoma**

A rare HPV-independent cervical adenocarcinoma arising from mesonephric remnants, usually presenting as a cervical mass or abnormal bleeding and requiring histopathologic diagnosis.

### **Chondrosarcoma Of The Breast**

An exceptionally rare malignant mesenchymal breast tumor producing cartilage. It is distinguished from metaplastic carcinoma and other sarcomas by histology and is managed with sarcoma-oriented complete excision.

### **Cutaneous Polyarteritis Nodosa**

A skin-limited necrotizing vasculitis of small- and medium-sized arteries, typically causing tender subcutaneous nodules, livedo reticularis, and ulcers on the lower legs without systemic organ involvement.

### **Cutaneous Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**

A clonal proliferation of Langerhans cells in the skin that may cause scaly papules, seborrheic dermatitis-like plaques, or purpura. Evaluation determines whether disease is skin-limited or involves other organs.

### **Cholesterosis**

Deposition of cholesterol esters in the gallbladder mucosa, producing yellow speckling or a "strawberry gallbladder." It is often incidental but may coexist with gallstones or chronic gallbladder inflammation.

### **Cranial Fasciitis**

A benign, rapidly growing fibroblastic proliferation of the scalp or cranial soft tissues, usually occurring in infants and young children and potentially mimicking a malignant tumor.

### **Cutaneous Leiomyoma**

A benign smooth-muscle tumor of the skin arising from arrector pili muscles, vascular smooth muscle, or the dartos. Multiple painful lesions may indicate hereditary leiomyomatosis and renal-cell cancer syndrome.

### **Giant Cell Tumor Of Soft Tissue**

A usually low-grade soft-tissue neoplasm containing numerous osteoclast-like giant cells, most often arising in the extremities of adults and generally having a favorable outcome after excision.

### **Extraskeletal Chondroma**

A benign hyaline-cartilage tumor occurring in soft tissue without attachment to bone, commonly in the hands or feet; it may calcify and resemble other cartilaginous lesions on imaging.

### **Extraskeletal Mesenchymal**

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## **Chondrosarcoma**

A malignant small-cell sarcoma with islands of malignant cartilage arising in soft tissue or other extraskeletal sites. It requires specialist pathologic and oncologic evaluation.

## **CNS Lymphoma**

A lymphoma involving the central nervous system, most often diffuse large B-cell lymphoma. It may involve brain parenchyma, meninges, eyes, or cerebrospinal fluid and requires urgent hematologic and neurologic evaluation.

## **CNS Infection**

Infection of the brain, spinal cord, meninges, or cerebrospinal-fluid spaces caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, parasites, or other organisms; presentation and treatment depend on the pathogen and anatomic site.

## **Congenital CNS Malformation**

A structural abnormality of the brain, spinal cord, or related developmental structures present from birth, caused by disturbed neural development or other prenatal factors; severity ranges from incidental to life-threatening.

## **Cerebral Cavernous Malformation**

A low-flow vascular malformation composed of dilated thin-walled vascular spaces in the brain or spinal cord. It may cause seizures, headaches, or hemorrhage, although some lesions remain asymptomatic.

## **Cardiac Myxoma**

The most common primary benign cardiac tumor, usually arising in the left atrium from the interatrial septum. It may cause positional obstruction, emboli, or constitutional symptoms and is generally treated by surgical excision.

## **Cardiac Transplantation**

Replacement of a failing heart with a donor heart for carefully selected patients with end-stage heart failure. Long-term care requires immunosuppression and surveillance for rejection, infection, and graft

vasculopathy.

## **Cardiac Allograft Vasculopathy**

A diffuse, progressive form of coronary arterial intimal thickening after heart transplantation that can cause silent ischemia, graft dysfunction, arrhythmia, or sudden death.

## **Chondromyxoid Fibroma**

A rare benign cartilage-forming bone tumor, usually arising in the metaphysis of a long bone and presenting with localized pain or an incidental radiographic lesion.

## **Benign Chondroblastoma**

A benign cartilage-producing bone tumor, usually arising in the epiphysis of adolescents and young adults and often causing joint-region pain.

## **Crystal-Induced Synovitis**

Acute or chronic joint inflammation caused by deposition of crystals such as monosodium urate, calcium pyrophosphate, or basic calcium phosphate in or around the joint.

## **Cardiovascular Risk Reduction**

Measures that lower the risk of myocardial infarction, stroke, heart failure, and vascular death through smoking cessation, blood-pressure and lipid control, diabetes management, physical activity, healthy diet, weight management, and indicated medicines.

## **Critical Care Nursing**

Specialized nursing care for critically ill patients requiring close monitoring, organ support, rapid assessment, complex therapies, and coordination with multidisciplinary intensive-care teams.





## D

### D And C

Dilation and curettage, a procedure that opens the cervix and removes tissue from the uterine lining for treatment or diagnosis.

### D And E

Dilation and evacuation, a surgical procedure in which the cervix is dilated and uterine contents are removed by suction and instruments.

### D-Dimer

A blood marker produced when cross-linked fibrin is broken down. It may be elevated in thrombosis and in many other conditions. A negative result can help exclude venous thromboembolism in appropriately selected patients with a low or intermediate pretest probability; the cutoff depends on the assay and clinical setting.

### D&C Instruments

Instruments used to dilate the cervix and remove tissue from the uterus during dilation and curettage.

### Dacrocytes (Teardrop Cells)

Teardrop-shaped red blood cells formed as erythrocytes are squeezed and deformed while exiting a fibrotic or infiltrated bone marrow space. Characteristic feature of Primary Myelofibrosis (JAK2 V617F mutation), bone marrow infiltration (myelophthisic anemia from metastatic cancer, granulomas, or leukemia), and severe thalassemia.

#### Synonyms:

Teardrop Cells

### Dacryoadenitis

Dacryoadenitis is inflammation of a tear-producing

lacrimal gland, causing painful swelling near the outer upper eyelid from infection, inflammation, or systemic disease. aspect of the upper eyelid with characteristic S-shaped ptosis. It can be acute or chronic in presentation.

### Dacryocystitis

Inflammation of the lacrimal sac, most commonly caused by obstruction of the nasolacrimal duct leading to stagnation of tears and secondary bacterial infection (*Staphylococcus aureus*, *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, *Haemophilus influenzae*).

### Dacryocystography

An imaging study in which contrast material is introduced into the lacrimal drainage system to identify narrowing or obstruction.

### Dacryocystorhinostomy

A surgical procedure creating a passage between the lacrimal sac and the nasal cavity to bypass an obstructed nasolacrimal duct.

### Dacryostenosis

Narrowing or obstruction of the lacrimal drainage passages, which can cause excessive tearing and recurrent infection of the lacrimal sac.

### Dactylitis

Inflammation of an entire digit (finger or toe), producing a diffuse, fusiform swelling often described as sausage-shaped.

### Dactylosymphysis

Abnormal fusion or webbing of adjacent digits, usually present from birth.

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## Daltonism

Color-vision deficiency, especially difficulty distinguishing certain colors because of abnormal or absent retinal cone function.

## DALY

Disability-adjusted life year, a measure combining years of healthy life lost because of premature death and disability.

## Damage-Control Resuscitation

A trauma strategy prioritizing rapid hemorrhage control, permissive approaches to blood pressure when appropriate, prevention of hypothermia, correction of coagulopathy, and balanced blood-product resuscitation rather than large-volume crystalloid administration.

## Damage-Control Surgery

A staged operative strategy for critically ill or severely injured patients in whom definitive repair is unsafe because of hypothermia, acidosis, coagulopathy, or physiologic instability. Initial surgery controls hemorrhage and contamination, followed by resuscitation and later definitive reconstruction.

## Dandruff

Scaling and shedding of the scalp skin, commonly associated with seborrheic dermatitis or dry skin.

## Dandruff And Scalp Conditions

Dandruff is a common scalp condition presenting as flaking, itching, and mild inflammation caused by overgrowth of the yeast *Malassezia*, dry skin, or seborrheic dermatitis. Other scalp conditions include psoriasis, contact dermatitis, ringworm tinea capitis, and head lice.

## Dandy Fever

Dengue fever, an acute mosquito-borne viral illness causing fever, headache, severe muscle or joint pain, and sometimes hemorrhage or shock.

## Dandy-Walker Malformation

A congenital hindbrain malformation characterized

by hypoplasia or aplasia of the cerebellar vermis, cystic dilation of the fourth ventricle, and posterior fossa enlargement with upward displacement of the tentorium, transverse sinuses, and torcular herophili.

## Dandy-Walker Syndrome

A congenital abnormality involving the cerebellum and the fluid spaces around it, often causing hydrocephalus or developmental problems.

## Dane Particle

The complete infectious particle of hepatitis B virus, consisting of the viral core and envelope.

## Daptomycin Resistance

Resistance to daptomycin can develop through mutations in genes encoding cell membrane phospholipid synthesis. The mechanism involves changes in the bacterial cell membrane that reduce daptomycin binding. Resistance is more common in VRE than MRSA. Resistance can emerge during therapy, particularly in endocarditis and bacteremia.

## Darier's Disease

An inherited skin disorder characterized by abnormal keratinization, greasy crusted papules, and nail changes, often worsened by heat and sweating.

## Dark Adaptation

The process by which the eyes become increasingly sensitive to dim light after moving from bright illumination into darkness.

## Dartos

A layer of smooth muscle and connective tissue beneath the skin of the scrotum that wrinkles the scrotal skin in response to temperature and other stimuli.

## Darwin's Tubercle

A variable small thickening or projection on the rim of the external ear, regarded as a remnant of an ancestral mammalian ear form.

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## **DASH Diet**

Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension. Emphasizes: fruits, vegetables, whole grains, low-fat dairy, reduced saturated fat, sodium <2300 mg/day. Lowers blood pressure effectively.

## **Daubenton's Plane**

An anatomical reference plane extending from the lower margin of the orbit to the upper margin of the external auditory opening, used in describing skull orientation.

## **Dawn Phenomenon**

Physiological increase in blood glucose occurring in the early morning hours between approximately three and eight AM driven by counter-regulatory hormone surges including growth hormone, cortisol, and catecholamines. More pronounced in patients with diabetes who lack the compensatory insulin response.

## **De Novo Variant**

A genetic variant present in an affected individual that was not detected in either biological parent, usually arising in a parental gamete or early embryogenesis. It may cause a dominant disorder and can have implications for recurrence risk in future pregnancies.

## **De Quervain Tendinitis**

Painful stenosing inflammation of the tendons of the abductor pollicis longus and extensor pollicis brevis in the first dorsal wrist compartment. It causes radial wrist pain worsened by thumb movement or grasping and is assessed clinically.

## **De Quervain Tenosynovitis**

De Quervain tenosynovitis: first dorsal compartment (APL, EPB) stenosis. Clinical: radial wrist pain, Finkelstein test (thumb in palm, ulnar deviation), swelling over radial styloid.

### **Synonyms:**

Tenosynovitis, De Quervain's

## **De-Escalation**

A set of verbal and nonverbal techniques used to reduce agitation and prevent violence while preserving dignity and safety. It includes calm communication, appropriate personal space, clear limits, environmental modification, and offering choices.

## **Dead Space**

The volume of ventilated air that does not participate in gas exchange. Anatomic dead space: the conducting airways (nose, pharynx, trachea, bronchi, terminal bronchioles) that warm, humidify, and filter inspired air but contain no alveoli for gas exchange. Approximately 150 mL in a 70 kg adult.

## **Dead Space Ventilation**

Ventilation of alveoli without perfusion ( $V/Q = \text{infinity}$ ). Anatomic dead space is the conducting airways (150 mL). Physiologic dead space includes alveoli without perfusion. Increased in PE, hypotension, and emphysema. Measured by the Bohr equation.

## **Dead Time**

The brief period after an event during which a detector or recording system cannot register another event, limiting the measured count rate.

## **Deafferentation**

Loss or interruption of sensory nerve input from a body region to the central nervous system, which may produce abnormal sensation or deafferentation pain.

## **Deafness**

Complete or severe loss of hearing. Hearing loss may be conductive, sensorineural, or mixed, depending on whether the problem affects sound transmission, the inner ear or auditory nerve, or both.

## **Death**

The permanent end of the functions that maintain a living organism.

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### Deauville Criteria

A five-point visual scale that compares fluorodeoxyglucose uptake on PET with reference tissues to assess treatment response in lymphoma.

### Debridement

The surgical removal of dead, damaged, or infected tissue from a wound to promote healing and prevent infection.

### Debulking

Surgical removal of as much tumor as possible when complete resection is not feasible, aiming to reduce tumor burden (cytoreduction) and improve response to subsequent therapy; central to ovarian cancer management.

### Decapitation

Separation of the head from the body, seen in severe trauma (vehicle accidents, train injuries, explosions), industrial accidents, hanging with judicial execution, or homicide. Complete decapitation is almost always rapidly fatal due to exsanguination and brain ischemia.

### Decay Correction

Mathematical adjustment for radioactive decay during imaging. Essential for quantitative comparison between studies.

### Deceased Donor

Individual who has died (usually from brain death or cardiac death) and donated organs, tissues, or both for transplantation.

### Decerebrate Posture

Abnormal extension of the arms and legs caused by severe dysfunction of the brainstem below the red nucleus. It is a sign of serious neurologic injury and may occur with traumatic brain injury, hemorrhage, or raised intracranial pressure.

### Decerebrate Posturing

Abnormal extension of the arms and legs, often with inward rotation of the arms, caused by severe

dysfunction below the cerebral hemispheres. It indicates serious neurologic injury, but posture alone does not determine outcome.

### Decerebration

Severe loss of cerebral function, often with extension and rigid posturing of the limbs from brainstem dysfunction; it may result from major injury or increased intracranial pressure.

### Decibel

A logarithmic unit (dB) used to measure the intensity of sound. The decibel scale compares a given sound pressure level to a reference level (0 dB = 20 micropascals, the threshold of normal hearing at 1 kHz). The scale is logarithmic: an increase of 10 dB represents a tenfold increase in sound intensity. Normal conversation: 60 dB.

### Decidua

The transformed endometrium of pregnancy, shed after delivery. Three regions: decidua basalis (under the placenta, site of trophoblast invasion), decidua capsularis (over the gestational sac, covering the embryo), and decidua parietalis (the remainder of the uterine lining).

### Deciduitis

Inflammation of the decidua, the specialized uterine lining of pregnancy.

### Deciduosis

The presence of extensive or ectopic decidual tissue, usually associated with pregnancy and sometimes involving the cervix, peritoneum, or other sites.

### Decision-Making Capacity

The clinical ability to understand relevant information, appreciate its consequences, reason about options, and communicate a stable choice regarding a specific decision. Capacity is decision-specific and may fluctuate; it is distinct from legal competence.

### Decompensated Cirrhosis

Cirrhosis complicated by clinically significant liver

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dysfunction or portal hypertension, commonly manifested by ascites, variceal hemorrhage, hepatic encephalopathy, or jaundice. It carries substantially higher mortality than compensated cirrhosis and warrants assessment for transplant and complication prevention.

### **Decomposition**

Postmortem breakdown of the body through autolysis and putrefaction. It begins within 24 to 72 hours at ambient temperature, producing green cecal discoloration, venous marbling, gas distension, skin slippage, and purge fluid.

### **Decompression Sickness**

A systemic illness caused by nitrogen bubble formation in tissues during rapid decompression, presenting with joint pain, skin mottling, and neurological deficits, treated with hyperbaric oxygen therapy.

### **Deconditioning**

Physiological decline from reduced activity or immobilization. Effects: muscle atrophy, weakness, decreased cardiorespiratory fitness, balance impairment, increased fall risk. Preventable with early mobilization, exercise. Reversible with rehabilitation.

### **Decontamination**

Measures that reduce continued absorption of a toxic substance from the skin, eyes, gastrointestinal tract, or clothing. Interventions are exposure-specific and may include removal from the source, irrigation, washing, activated charcoal, or specialist procedures.

### **Decorticate Posture**

Abnormal flexion of the arms with extension of the legs, indicating severe damage affecting the cerebral hemispheres, internal capsule, or thalamus. It is a sign of major brain injury and impaired consciousness.

### **Decorticate Posturing**

Abnormal flexion of the arms with extension of the legs, caused by severe dysfunction of the brain. It

indicates serious neurologic injury, but posture alone does not determine outcome.

### **Decreased Breath Sounds**

Diminished air movement heard on auscultation, indicating decreased ventilation. Causes include pneumothorax, pleural effusion, atelectasis, and mucus plugging. Unilateral decreased breath sounds may indicate tension pneumothorax or large effusion.

### **Decubitus Ulcer**

Localized damage to the skin and/or underlying soft tissue caused by prolonged pressure, shear, or friction, most commonly over bony prominences. See pressure injury.

### **Deep**

Located further inward from the surface of the body.

### **Deep Tendon Reflex**

The monosynaptic stretch reflex elicited by tapping a tendon with a reflex hammer, testing the integrity of the reflex arc (sensory afferent, spinal cord, motor efferent). Common reflexes: biceps (C5-6), triceps (C7), brachioradialis (C5-6), knee/patellar (L3-4), ankle/Achilles (S1). Graded 0 (absent) to 4+ (hyperactive, clonus).

### **Deep Vein Thrombosis**

A clot in a deep vein, usually of the lower limb, caused by a combination of reduced blood flow, increased clotting tendency, or vessel-wall injury. Anticoagulant treatment is used when indicated.

#### **Synonyms:**

DVT (Deep Vein Thrombosis)

### **Deep Vein Thrombosis Ultrasound**

Venous duplex ultrasound used to evaluate suspected deep-vein thrombosis. The test assesses vein compressibility and blood flow; an abnormal result is interpreted with the clinical probability and, when needed, repeat or additional testing.

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## Deep Venous Reflux

Retrograde flow through incompetent venous valves in the deep venous system. It contributes to chronic venous hypertension, edema, skin changes, and venous ulcer formation.

## Deep Venous Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot in a deep vein, most often in the leg.

## Defecation

The process of eliminating feces from the body. Filling of the rectum triggers stretch receptors that initiate the defecation reflex via the sacral spinal cord (S2-S4), causing contraction of the rectal wall and relaxation of the internal anal sphincter.

## Defecography

Dynamic imaging of the rectum and pelvic floor during defecation using fluoroscopy or MRI. The rectum is filled with contrast paste and the patient performs defecation while images are captured. Evaluates rectal prolapse, intussusception, rectocele, enterocele, and pelvic floor dyssynergia.

## Defense Mechanisms

Psychological processes, often outside conscious awareness, that help a person manage distress or conflict. Examples include denial, projection, repression, humor, and sublimation.

## Defense Mechanisms (Forensic)

Physical evidence patterns on a body demonstrating active resistance against an assailant prior to incapacitation.

### Synonyms:

Forensic

## Defense Wounds

Injuries sustained by a victim attempting to ward off an attack, typically found on the flexor surfaces of hands, palms, wrists, and forearms (incised/stab wounds from knives or contusions/abrasions from blunt force).

## Defense Wounds (Inscribed)

Cuts or other injuries on the hands or forearms that may occur when a person attempts to protect against an attack. The distribution and morphology of defensive injuries may help reconstruct an assault but are not independently proof of a particular event.

### Synonyms:

Inscribed

## Defibrillation

Delivery of an unsynchronized electrical shock to terminate ventricular fibrillation or pulseless ventricular tachycardia by depolarizing a critical mass of myocardium. It is distinct from synchronized cardioversion, which times the shock to the QRS complex.

## Defibrillator

Device delivering electric shock to heart. Types: external (AED, manual), internal (implantable). Used for ventricular fibrillation, pulseless ventricular tachycardia. Energy: biphasic 120-200 J.

## Defibrillator Implant

An implanted cardioverter-defibrillator that detects and treats dangerous ventricular rhythms with electrical pacing or shock.

## Degenerative Spine Disease

Lumbar spinal stenosis: central (neurogenic claudication: bilateral leg pain with walking, relieved by sitting/flexion), lateral recess, foraminal. Imaging: MRI (central canal AP diameter <10mm, cross-sectional area <70mm<sup>2</sup>).

## Dehydration

Dehydration occurs when body water loss exceeds intake, causing thirst, reduced urination, dizziness, tachycardia, electrolyte abnormalities, or shock when severe. proportional), hypotonic (sodium loss > water). Causes: vomiting, diarrhea, fever, inadequate intake, diabetes insipidus. Treatment: oral rehydration or IV fluids.



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## Dehydration In Children

A deficit of total body water, usually caused by gastrointestinal losses, inadequate intake, fever, or renal losses. Clinical assessment includes mental status, heart rate, mucous membranes, tears, capillary refill, urine output, weight change, and perfusion rather than a single sign.

## Delayed Cord Clamping

The practice of delaying umbilical cord clamping for  $\geq 30$ –60 seconds after delivery, allowing placental transfusion of blood to the newborn. Benefits: increases neonatal blood volume by 30%, improves iron stores (ferritin, hemoglobin) for the first 6 months, reduces anemia, and improves transitional circulation.

## Delayed Ejaculation

A sexual dysfunction characterized by a persistent or recurrent delay in, infrequency of, or absence of ejaculation during partnered sexual activity, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing marked distress. Prevalence: 1-5% of men. Lifelong vs. acquired.

## Delayed Emergence

Prolonged time to regain consciousness after discontinuation of anesthetic agents. Failure to regain consciousness within 30-60 minutes of completing surgery.

## Delayed Hypersensitivity

A delayed immune reaction, usually mediated by T cells rather than antibodies, that develops hours to days after exposure. Examples include contact dermatitis, the tuberculin reaction, and some drug eruptions.

## Delayed Puberty

Failure to develop secondary sexual characteristics by age thirteen in girls and age fourteen in boys. Causes include constitutional delay which is the most common, chronic illness, malnutrition, hypogonadotropic hypogonadism from Kallmann syndrome or pituitary disease, and hypergonadotropic hypogonadism from gonadal failure.

## Deletion

Loss of chromosomal segment. Terminal deletion: loss from end. Interstitial deletion: loss from middle. Microdeletion syndromes: 22q11.2 deletion (DiGeorge), 5p deletion (Cri-du-chat).

## Delirium

Delirium is an acute fluctuating disturbance of attention and awareness caused by an underlying medical, medication-related, toxic, or environmental factor.

## Delirium In Anesthesia

Delirium is an acute confusional state characterized by fluctuating consciousness, inattention, disorganized thinking, and altered level of awareness. Postoperative delirium occurs in 15 to 50 percent of elderly surgical patients, with higher rates in hip fracture and cardiac surgery.

## Delirium Tremens

A severe, potentially life-threatening form of alcohol withdrawal characterized by fluctuating confusion, agitation, hallucinations, and marked autonomic overactivity. It usually occurs after cessation or major reduction of prolonged heavy alcohol use and requires urgent medical treatment.

## Delivery

The process of childbirth: vaginal delivery (spontaneous vertex most common; assisted—vacuum, forceps) or cesarean delivery (abdominal). Stages of labor culminate in delivery of the infant and placenta.

## Delivery Of Posterior Arm

A shoulder dystocia maneuver: the operator's hand enters the posterior vagina along the fetal chest, finds the fetal hand, grasps the forearm, sweeps it across the chest and face, and delivers the posterior arm and hand over the perineum. This reduces the bisacromial diameter by 20% and is often highly effective.

## Deltoid Muscle

Large triangular muscle forming the shoulder contour, from lateral clavicle, acromion, and scapular

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spine to the deltoid tuberosity. Innervated by the axillary nerve (C5-C6). Anterior fibers flex/medially rotate, middle fibers abduct (primary abductor beyond 15 degrees), posterior fibers extend/laterally rotate.

### **Delusion**

A fixed belief that is not consistent with available evidence or the person's sociocultural context and is not readily changed by reasoned discussion. Delusions may be persecutory, grandiose, referential, somatic, nihilistic, or erotomanic.

### **Delusional Disorder**

A disorder characterized by the presence of one or more delusions lasting one month or more in the context of relatively preserved functioning. The delusions are non-bizarre (involving real-life situations that could conceivably occur, such as being followed, infected, loved from afar, or conspired against).

### **Dementia**

Dementia is acquired decline in one or more cognitive domains that interferes with independent function; causes include neurodegenerative, vascular, metabolic, infectious, and other disorders. Alzheimer disease, vascular disease, Lewy body disease, frontotemporal disorders, and other conditions. Evaluation is important because some causes of cognitive decline may be treatable.

#### **Synonyms:**

Children Dementia (Dementia) Pugilistica Dementia (Dementia)

### **Dementia (Major Neurocognitive Disorder)**

Dementia is the common clinical term for an acquired syndrome of decline in one or more cognitive domains that interferes with independence in daily activities. Major neurocognitive disorder is the preferred diagnostic classification term.

#### **Synonyms:**

Major Neurocognitive Disorder

### **Demyelinating Disease**

A disease in which the myelin sheath surrounding nerve fibres is damaged, slowing or blocking neural conduction.

### **Dendrite**

The branched, tapering neuronal processes that receive synaptic input from other neurons and conduct graded potentials toward the cell body. Dendrites contain receptors, ion channels, and postsynaptic densities.

### **Dendritic Cell**

The most potent professional antigen-presenting cell, capturing antigens in tissues and migrating to lymph nodes to present peptides on MHC molecules to T cells, initiating adaptive immunity.

### **Dendritic Ulcer**

A branching epithelial ulcer of the cornea, classically caused by herpes simplex virus. It may cause a red eye, pain, light sensitivity, tearing, or reduced vision and requires ophthalmic assessment.

### **Denervate**

Loss of nerve supply to a tissue or organ; may occur surgically, traumatically, or through disease processes.

### **Dengue**

A mosquito-borne viral infection that commonly causes fever, headache, muscle pain, joint pain, and rash. Severe disease can cause bleeding or shock.

### **Dengue Fever**

Dengue fever is a mosquito-borne viral illness causing fever, headache, muscle and joint pain, rash, and sometimes plasma leakage, bleeding, or shock. flavivirus transmitted primarily by *Aedes aegypti* mosquitoes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever

### **Dengue Virus**

A positive-sense RNA virus belonging to the Fla-

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viviridae family that causes dengue fever. The virus has four serotypes, and infection with one serotype provides lifelong immunity to that serotype but only temporary cross-protection against others.

### **Denial**

A defense mechanism in which a person refuses to accept an unpleasant reality. It is a common initial response to traumatic events and terminal illness diagnoses. While adaptive in the short term, chronic denial can prevent appropriate medical treatment and psychological processing.

### **Denosumab For Osteoporosis**

Fully human monoclonal antibody targeting RANK ligand preventing osteoclast formation activation and survival. Reduces fracture risk at the spine hip and non-vertebral sites. Administered as subcutaneous injection every six months. Advantages include no renal dose adjustment and effectiveness even with oral bisphosphonate intolerance.

### **Dens**

The tooth-like projection of the second cervical vertebra that forms a pivot for rotation of the first vertebra.

### **Dens Evaginatus**

An extra cusp or tubercle on a tooth, most often a premolar. It may contain an extension of the dental pulp and may fracture or become affected by caries.

### **Dens Invaginatus**

An inward folding of enamel and dentin that may extend toward or into the dental pulp, allowing debris to collect and increasing the risk of caries and pulpal infection.

### **Dental Abscess**

A localized collection of pus arising from infection of a tooth or the surrounding periodontal tissues. It may cause toothache, percussion tenderness, gingival swelling, facial swelling, fever, trismus, or regional lymphadenopathy; spread into deep facial spaces can threaten the airway and requires urgent assessment.

### **Dental Age**

An estimate of developmental age based on the formation, mineralization, and eruption of the teeth. It is useful in children but is not an exact measure of chronological age.

### **Dental Anesthesia**

The use of local anesthetic, sedation, or, when necessary, general anesthesia to control pain and anxiety during dental care.

### **Dental Caries**

A disease in which bacterial acids progressively demineralize and damage the teeth. See Dental Cavities.

### **Dental Cavities**

Permanent areas of tooth decay caused by acid-producing bacteria acting on dietary carbohydrates. Cavities progress from enamel demineralization to dentin and pulp involvement, causing sensitivity, pain, or infection.

### **Dental Ceramic**

A ceramic material used to make dental restorations such as crowns, veneers, and bridges. Examples include feldspathic ceramic, lithium disilicate, and zirconia.

### **Dental Disease**

Disorders affecting the teeth, gums, or supporting tissues, including tooth decay, gum disease, oral infections, and tooth loss. Prevention includes fluoride, regular brushing and flossing, limiting frequent sugar exposure, and routine dental examinations.

### **Dental Extraction**

Removal of a tooth from its alveolar socket. Indications include unrestorable disease, advanced periodontal destruction, impaction, orthodontic treatment, or selected prosthodontic needs; risks include bleeding, infection, nerve injury, fracture, and alveolar osteitis.

### **Dental Implant**

A biocompatible fixture placed in the jawbone to

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support a replacement tooth. The fixture may become integrated with surrounding bone and is restored with a crown, bridge, or denture.

### **Dental Plaque**

Biofilm of bacteria on tooth surfaces. Initiated by acquired pellicle. Maturation leads to disease if not removed. Disrupted by mechanical cleaning.

### **Dental Pulp Necrosis**

Death of the dental pulp, usually following untreated inflammation, trauma, or loss of blood supply. The tooth generally fails sensibility testing and may develop apical periodontitis or a periapical abscess.

### **Dental Pulpitis**

Inflammation of the dental pulp caused by caries, trauma, restorative procedures, cracks, or other irritation. Reversible pulpitis produces brief provoked pain, whereas irreversible pulpitis causes spontaneous or lingering pain and may require pulpal treatment or extraction.

### **Dental Radiographs**

Imaging for dental diagnosis. Intraoral: periapical (tooth root and surrounding bone), bitewing (interproximal caries detection, crestal bone level), and occlusal (larger area, localization).

### **Dental Radiography**

Imaging techniques for dental diagnosis: bitewing (caries, bone levels), periapical (root, periapical tissues), panoramic (full mouth overview), CBCT (3D imaging). Radiation dose: dental radiography low exposure. ALARA principle applies.

### **Dental Restorative Materials**

Materials used to restore teeth: amalgam, composite resin, glass ionomer, ceramic, gold alloy. Selection based on location, aesthetics, strength, cost, patient factors. Composite: tooth-colored, adhesive, conservative preparation. Ceramic: excellent aesthetics, brittle, expensive. Gold: durable, biocompatible, aesthetic concern.

### **Dental Screening**

Examination of the teeth, gums, and mouth to identify dental disease or risk before serious symptoms develop.

### **Dental Sealant**

Thin protective coating applied to chewing surfaces of molars. Prevents caries by sealing pits and fissures.

### **Dental Traumatology**

Management of dental injuries. Types: enamel fractures, enamel-dentin fractures, pulp exposure, root fractures, avulsion. Immediate care critical for avulsed teeth.

### **Dentin**

Calcified tissue beneath enamel forming bulk of tooth. Contains dentinal tubules with fluid and processes. Sensitive to stimuli when exposed. Reparative dentin formed in response to irritation.

### **Dentinogenesis Imperfecta**

An inherited disorder of dentin formation that can cause translucent blue-gray or amber teeth that fracture, wear, or become discolored easily. Some forms occur with osteogenesis imperfecta.

### **Dentistry (Geriatric)**

Oral health challenges in elderly: xerostomia, root caries, periodontal disease, denture problems, oral cancer, medication side effects. Assessment: complete oral exam, cancer screening, denture fit, caries risk. Prevention: fluoride, oral hygiene, regular dental visits. Adaptations: handholds, magnification, positioning.

### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Dentition**

The teeth present in the mouth, including their number, arrangement, development, and eruption.

### **Denture**

A removable dental prosthesis that replaces some or

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all missing teeth and associated oral tissues. Partial dentures replace selected teeth while complete dentures replace an entire dental arch; fit, oral hygiene, tissue health, and regular review are important for function and prevention of mucosal injury.

### **Dependence**

A state in which repeated exposure to a substance produces physiologic adaptation, so that stopping or reducing it may cause withdrawal. In substance-use disorders, dependence may occur with or without addiction.

### **Dependent Personality Disorder**

A pattern of submissive and clinging behavior related to an excessive need to be taken care of.

### **Depersonalization-Derealization Disorder**

A disorder involving persistent or recurrent feelings of detachment from one's thoughts, feelings, body, or surroundings, while reality testing remains intact. Symptoms cause clinically significant distress or impairment.

### **Depolarization**

The change in membrane potential toward a less negative (more positive) value, typically caused by inward sodium or calcium current. In neurons, depolarization to threshold triggers an action potential.

### **Depot Implant**

An implant designed to release a medicine gradually over an extended period after placement in the body.

### **Deprescribing**

A planned, supervised process of reducing the dose or stopping a medication for which harms, burden, or lack of benefit outweigh expected benefit. It requires review of indication, withdrawal risk, disease recurrence, and patient goals.

### **Depression**

Depression is a mood disorder involving persistent depressed mood or loss of interest with cognitive, physical, and behavioral symptoms that impair func-

tioning. persistent sadness and loss of interest or pleasure in activities, affecting approximately 7 percent of adults worldwide annually.

#### **Synonyms:**

Clinical Depression (Depression)

### **Depression (Geriatric)**

Mood disorder common in elderly, often underdiagnosed. Symptoms: sad mood, anhedonia, sleep/appetite changes, fatigue, guilt, concentration difficulty, suicidal ideation. May present as cognitive impairment ("pseudodementia"). Risk factors: chronic illness, social isolation, bereavement, medications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Depression Screening**

Major depressive disorder is a common, disabling mood disorder characterized by persistent sadness and loss of interest or pleasure in activities, affecting approximately 7 percent of adults worldwide annually. See depression.

### **Dermal Structure**

The dermis has two layers: papillary dermis (superficial, thin, containing capillaries, lymphatics, and Meissner corpuscles) and reticular dermis (deep, thick, containing dense irregular connective tissue, collagen, elastin, hair follicles, sweat glands, and sebaceous glands).

### **Dermatitis**

Inflammation of the skin, often used interchangeably with eczema. Atopic dermatitis: chronic pruritic inflammation in flexural areas, associated with asthma and allergies, driven by skin barrier dysfunction and type 2 inflammation. Contact dermatitis: allergic (type IV hypersensitivity) or irritant (direct toxicity).

### **Dermatitis Herpetiformis**

A chronic, intensely pruritic, autoimmune blistering skin condition characterized by grouped, symmetric erythematous papules, urticarial plaques, and vesicles occurring primarily on extensor surfaces



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(elbows, knees, buttocks, scalp). It is a cutaneous manifestation of gluten-sensitive enteropathy (celiac disease).

### **Dermatofibroma**

A common benign dermal nodule, typically on the lower extremities of young adults. It presents as a firm, hyperpigmented papule that dimples when pinched (Fitzpatrick sign). It is thought to result from reactive fibrosis following minor trauma or insect bites. Dermatofibromas are asymptomatic and require no treatment.

### **Dermatofibrosarcoma**

Dermatofibrosarcoma protuberans is a locally aggressive fibrohistiocytic tumor of the skin. It typically presents as a slowly enlarging, indurated plaque on the trunk, which may develop nodules over time. It has a high local recurrence rate (up to 50 percent with simple excision) but low metastatic potential.

### **Dermatofibrosarcoma Protuberans**

A rare locally aggressive cutaneous sarcoma arising from dermal fibroblasts. It presents as a slow-growing, firm, reddish-purple plaque or nodule, typically on the trunk. It has a high local recurrence rate but low metastatic potential. Treatment is wide local excision with Mohs micrographic surgery or imatinib for unresectable disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

DFSP

### **Dermatographism**

Urticaria factitia: the development of linear wheals (hives) within minutes of stroking or scratching the skin, the most common form of physical urticaria. Mast cell hyper-reactivity releases histamine after minor mechanical pressure. Associated with chronic spontaneous urticaria and atopy.

### **Dermatomyositis**

Dermatomyositis is an autoimmune inflammatory myopathy characterized by proximal muscle weakness and distinctive skin findings, with possible lung, swallowing, or cancer associations. (knuckles),

heliotrope rash (purple periorbital), shawl/V sign erythema, and proximal muscle weakness; associated with interstitial lung disease, and in adults an increased risk of malignancy (ovary, lung, GI).

### **Dermatopathology**

The study of skin disease through examination of tissue specimens, usually with microscopy and related laboratory methods. It helps identify inflammatory, infectious, benign, and malignant skin disorders.

### **Dermatophytosis**

A superficial infection of keratinized skin, hair, or nails caused by dermatophyte fungi, producing conditions such as tinea corporis, tinea pedis, and onychomycosis.

### **Dermis**

Thick connective tissue layer beneath the epidermis providing structural support, elasticity, and nourishment. Two layers: papillary (superficial, loose connective tissue with dermal papillae interdigitating with epidermal ridges) and reticular (deep, dense irregular connective tissue).

### **Dermoid**

A benign cystic teratoma containing elements derived from ectoderm, including skin, hair follicles, sebaceous glands, and sometimes teeth. Ovarian dermoid cysts are the most common germ cell tumor of the ovary, typically occurring in young women. They are usually asymptomatic but may cause torsion, rupture, or malignant transformation.

### **Dermoid Cyst**

A usually benign cyst lined by tissue resembling skin and sometimes containing hair, glands, or other skin structures.

### **Dermoscopy**

Noninvasive examination of skin lesions with magnification and polarized or nonpolarized illumination that reveals structures not visible to the unaided eye. It improves assessment of pigmented lesions and selected inflammatory or infectious conditions but does not replace biopsy when malignancy is



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suspected.

### **Descending Colon**

From the splenic flexure to the left iliac fossa, approximately 25-30 cm, and mostly retroperitoneal and fixed to the posterior abdominal wall. The phrenicocolic ligament supports the splenic flexure. Anteriorly it is related to small intestine; posteriorly to the left kidney. It absorbs water and electrolytes and compacts fecal matter.

### **Descending Thoracic Aorta**

The portion of the aorta extending from the aortic arch to the diaphragm. It lies in the posterior mediastinum and gives branches to the thoracic wall and organs.

### **Desmoid Tumor**

A locally aggressive but non-metastasizing fibrous tumor (fibromatosis), associated with familial adenomatous polyposis. Treatment includes surgery, radiation, and systemic therapy; recurrence after resection is common.

### **Desquamative Interstitial Pneumonia**

A rare ILD characterized by uniform filling of alveoli with macrophages containing brown pigment (hemosiderin-laden). It is strongly associated with smoking. HRCT shows bilateral ground-glass opacities with lower lobe predominance. Smoking cessation and corticosteroids are the main treatments.

### **Detached Retina**

Separation of the neurosensory retina from the underlying retinal pigment epithelium (RPE), a medical emergency requiring prompt surgical repair to prevent permanent vision loss.

### **Deterministic Effects**

Tissue reactions caused by radiation that generally occur only above a threshold dose, with severity increasing as the dose rises. Examples include skin injury, cataracts, and tissue damage after substantial exposure.

### **Detoxification**

Removal of toxic substance from body. Methods: activated charcoal, gastric lavage (rarely used), whole bowel irrigation, hemodialysis, hemoperfusion, chelation, supportive care.

### **Developmental Dysplasia Of The Hip**

A spectrum of hip abnormalities in infants and children, ranging from mild acetabular dysplasia to complete hip dislocation. The femoral head is partially or completely displaced from the acetabulum due to capsular laxity and acetabular underdevelopment.

### **Developmental Milestones**

Skills and abilities that children typically acquire at predictable ages. Examples: social smile at 2 months, rolling over at 4-6 months, sitting independently at 6-8 months, walking at 12 months, and speaking two-word phrases at 2 years. Delays in reaching milestones may indicate developmental delay, autism, or neurologic impairment.

### **Developmental Regression**

Loss of previously acquired developmental skills. Regression is a neurologic red flag requiring prompt evaluation for genetic, metabolic, neurodegenerative, epileptic, infectious, or structural causes.

### **Developmental Surveillance**

The ongoing process of eliciting caregiver concerns, observing the child, documenting developmental history, and monitoring milestones during routine care. It differs from formal developmental screening, which uses standardized instruments at specified ages.

### **Deviated Septum**

Displacement of the nasal septum from the midline, congenital or acquired from trauma, and present to some degree in most adults. Significant deviation narrows one nasal cavity, impairing airflow and sinus drainage and producing obstruction, congestion, recurrent sinusitis, epistaxis, and sleep disturbance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Septum Deviated (Deviated Septum)

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## Devic Disease

Neuromyelitis optica spectrum disorder, an autoimmune disease that primarily affects the optic nerves and spinal cord.

## DEXA (Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry)

Measures bone mineral density (BMD) at spine and hip. T-score compares to young adult reference. Osteoporosis: T-score  $\leq -2.5$ . Osteopenia: -1.0 to -2.5. Low radiation dose.

### Synonyms:

Dual-Energy X-ray Absorptiometry

## Dexamethasone Suppression Test

A dynamic test used to assess cortisol regulation. In normal physiology, dexamethasone suppresses ACTH and cortisol; failure of suppression supports endogenous hypercortisolism but requires interpretation with medication, absorption, and comorbidity considerations.

## Dextrocardia

A congenital position in which the heart lies predominantly on the right side of the chest, sometimes with reversed internal organs or associated heart defects.

## Diabetes

Diabetes is chronic hyperglycemia caused by inadequate insulin secretion, insulin resistance, or both, with long-term risks to the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, and blood vessels. inadequate insulin secretion, impaired insulin action, or both. Chronic hyperglycemia can damage the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, and blood vessels. Major forms include type 1, type 2, and gestational diabetes.

## Diabetes And Metabolic Health

Closely linked through insulin resistance, obesity, dyslipidemia, and hypertension, collectively known as the metabolic syndrome. Poor metabolic health increases the risk of developing type 2 diabetes and worsens glycemic control in existing diabetes.

## Diabetes Complications

Diabetes complications arise from chronic hyperglycemia damaging blood vessels and nerves over time. Microvascular complications include diabetic retinopathy leading to vision loss, nephropathy progressing to kidney failure, and neuropathy causing pain and loss of sensation.

## Diabetes Insipidus

A disorder of water balance caused by deficient vasopressin action, leading to excessive dilute urine and thirst. hours) and polydipsia due to deficient secretion of antidiuretic hormone (ADH, vasopressin) from the posterior pituitary (central diabetes insipidus) or renal resistance to ADH action (nephrogenic diabetes insipidus).

## Diabetes Management

The coordinated use of nutrition, physical activity, medicines when indicated, glucose monitoring, and screening for complications to maintain health and reduce diabetes-related risk.

## Diabetes Medications

Diabetes medications lower blood glucose through various mechanisms: metformin reduces hepatic glucose production; sulfonylureas stimulate insulin secretion; SGLT2 inhibitors increase urinary glucose excretion; GLP-1 receptor agonists enhance incretin effects; and insulin replaces deficient hormone.

## Diabetes Mellitus

A metabolic disorder characterized by chronic hyperglycemia resulting from insufficient insulin production, insulin resistance, or both. Type 1 diabetes results from autoimmune destruction of pancreatic beta cells, while type 2 is driven by genetic and lifestyle factors leading to insulin resistance.

### Synonyms:

Diabetes (Diabetes Mellitus)

## Diabetes Mellitus Type 1

An autoimmune disease characterized by destruction of pancreatic beta cells leading to absolute insulin deficiency. Usually presents in childhood or young adulthood with acute onset of polyuria, polydipsia,

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weight loss, and diabetic ketoacidosis (DKA) at diagnosis in many.

### **Diabetes Mellitus Type 2**

A progressive metabolic disorder characterized by insulin resistance and relative insulin deficiency, strongly associated with obesity and physical inactivity. Typically presents in adults but increasingly seen in younger populations. Diagnosis: fasting glucose  $\geq 126$  mg/dL, HbA1c  $\geq 6.5\%$ , or OGTT  $\geq 200$  mg/dL.

### **Diabetes Prevention**

Preventing diabetes focuses on reducing the risk of developing type 2 diabetes through lifestyle interventions and risk factor management. Maintaining a healthy body weight, engaging in regular physical activity, and following a balanced diet low in refined sugars and saturated fats are cornerstone strategies.

### **Diabetic Autonomic Neuropathy**

Dysfunction of autonomic nerves caused by diabetes, affecting cardiovascular, gastrointestinal, genitourinary, sudomotor, and pupillary systems. Manifestations include orthostatic hypotension, resting tachycardia, gastroparesis, bladder dysfunction, erectile dysfunction, and impaired hypoglycemia awareness.

### **Diabetic Cardiomyopathy**

Damage to the heart muscle associated with diabetes that occurs independently of coronary artery disease or hypertension. It may cause impaired relaxation, reduced pumping function, heart failure, and rhythm problems; glucose and cardiovascular risk control can reduce risk.

### **Diabetic Complications**

The chronic and acute consequences of diabetes mellitus. Microvascular: retinopathy (leading cause of blindness), nephropathy (leading cause of ESRD—albuminuria, declining GFR), neuropathy (peripheral—stocking-glove, autonomic—gastroparesis, erectile dysfunction, postural hypotension, cardiac autonomic).

### **Diabetic Diet**

An individualized eating plan that considers carbohydrate amount and timing, overall nutrition, cultural preferences, and treatment goals to support blood-glucose control.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diet Diabetes (Diabetic Diet)

### **Diabetic Foot**

Foot problems associated with diabetes, including neuropathy, deformity, ulcers, infection, and impaired healing.

### **Diabetic Foot Disease**

Complex multifactorial condition resulting from the combination of peripheral neuropathy, peripheral arterial disease, and impaired immune function in diabetes. Neuropathy leads to loss of protective sensation and foot deformities. Peripheral arterial disease impairs healing. Minor trauma progresses to ulceration and infection.

### **Diabetic Foot Ulcer**

A chronic wound of the foot in a patient with diabetes, resulting from peripheral neuropathy, peripheral artery disease, and impaired wound healing. Neuropathic ulcers: painless, at pressure points (plantar metatarsal heads, heel), punched-out appearance, surrounded by callus.

### **Diabetic Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State**

A severe complication of diabetes marked by extreme hyperglycemia, increased serum osmolality, and dehydration with little or no ketoacidosis. It can cause altered consciousness and requires urgent hospital treatment.

### **Diabetic Ketoacidosis**

An acute, life-threatening diabetes complication characterized by ketone production and metabolic acidosis, usually with elevated blood glucose. It may be triggered by infection, insufficient insulin, myocardial infarction, pancreatitis, or other physiologic stress.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Coma Diabetic (Diabetic Ketoacidosis) Ketoacidosis, Diabetic Ketoacidosis Diabetic (Diabetic Ketoacidosis)

### Diabetic Ketoacidosis Monitoring

Monitoring during DKA management includes hourly blood glucose measurement, serum electrolytes every two to four hours, venous blood gas assessment, beta-hydroxybutyrate levels, and fluid balance.

### Diabetic Macular Edema

The accumulation of fluid within the macula due to breakdown of the blood-retinal barrier in diabetic retinopathy, resulting in thickening of the macula and central vision loss, and it can occur at any stage of diabetic retinopathy, from mild non-proliferative to proliferative disease.

### Diabetic Nephropathy

Kidney disease caused by diabetes mellitus, the leading cause of ESRD worldwide.

Pathophysiology: hyperglycemia-induced glomerular hyperfiltration, basement membrane thickening, mesangial expansion, and glomerulosclerosis. Presents with progressive albuminuria (microalbuminuria macroalbuminuria) and declining GFR.

**Synonyms:**

DKD

### Diabetic Neuropathy

Nerve dysfunction caused by diabetes. It may cause distal sensory loss and pain or affect autonomic functions such as digestion, blood pressure, sweating, bladder function, or sexual function.

**Synonyms:**

Autonomic Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Neuropathy, Diabetic Neuropathy Autonomic Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Neuropathy Diabetic Peripheral (Diabetic Neuropathy) Neuropathy Focal Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Neuropathy Proximal Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Peripheral Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy) Proximal Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)

### Diabetic Peripheral Neuropathy

The most common complication of diabetes mellitus, affecting approximately fifty percent of patients with long-standing disease. It is a length-dependent, sensorimotor polyneuropathy that affects the distal lower extremities first, in a glove-and-stocking distribution, and progresses proximally over time.

### Diabetic Retinopathy

A microvascular complication of diabetes mellitus and a leading cause of blindness in working-age adults. Non-proliferative DR (NPDR): microaneurysms, dot-blot hemorrhages, exudates (hard and cotton-wool spots), and venous beading. Proliferative DR (PDR): retinal neovascularization, vitreous hemorrhage, and tractional retinal detachment.

**Synonyms:**

Retinopathy, Diabetic

### Diagnosis

The identification of a disease or other health condition through clinical history, examination, and appropriate investigations. A differential diagnosis considers alternative explanations for the findings.

### Diagnostic Microbiology

The laboratory identification of microorganisms causing disease. Methods include microscopy, culture, biochemical testing, serology, and molecular methods. Rapid diagnostic tests provide same-day results. MALDI-TOF mass spectrometry revolutionized bacterial identification.

### Diagnostic Radiology

The medical specialty that uses imaging methods to diagnose and characterize disease, including X-ray, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and nuclear medicine.

### Diagnostic Test

A test used to evaluate a person with symptoms, signs, or an abnormal screening result to establish, exclude, or characterize a disease. Its usefulness depends on analytic validity, clinical performance, and the consequences of the result.

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## Diagnostic Uncertainty

The state in which available information does not establish a single diagnosis with sufficient confidence. It should be communicated transparently and managed with safety-netting, planned reassessment, and targeted additional evaluation.

## Dialectical Behavior Therapy

A comprehensive cognitive-behavioral treatment originally developed for borderline personality disorder. It combines cognitive-behavioral techniques with mindfulness and acceptance strategies. Core modules include mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation, and interpersonal effectiveness.

## Dialysis

Removal of excess fluid and waste products from the blood when kidney function is inadequate, using hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis.

## Dialysis Access

A vascular route used for hemodialysis, such as an arteriovenous fistula, arteriovenous graft, or central venous catheter. Each option has different benefits and risks.

## Dialysis Adequacy

The degree to which a dialysis prescription removes uremic solutes and controls fluid, electrolyte, and acid-base balance while meeting patient-centered treatment goals. Measures such as Kt/V and urea reduction ratio are used for hemodialysis, but clinical status remains essential.

## Dialysis Disequilibrium Syndrome

Neurological complications during hemodialysis in severely uremic patients. Headache, nausea, confusion, seizures, and coma. Results from rapid solute removal causing cerebral edema. Prevent with gradual dialysis initiation and shorter initial sessions.

## Diaper Rash

Irritant inflammation of the skin covered by a diaper, commonly caused by prolonged contact with urine or stool, friction, moisture, or *Candida* infection. It causes redness and soreness; persistent, severe, or

spreading rash requires evaluation for infection or another skin condition.

## Diaphragm

Dome-shaped musculotendinous partition separating thoracic/abdominal cavities, primary inspiration muscle. Central tendon with muscular periphery from xiphoid, lower six costal cartilages, and lumbar vertebrae via crura and arcuate ligaments. Innervated by phrenic nerves (C3-C5). Contraction flattens the dome increasing thoracic volume.

## Diaphragmatic Hernia

Protrusion of abdominal contents through a defect or opening in the diaphragm into the thoracic cavity. It may be congenital or acquired after trauma and can cause respiratory compromise, bowel obstruction, or strangulation; diagnosis is based on imaging and management depends on symptoms, contents, and the risk of organ compromise.

## Diaphragmatic Rupture

A tear in the diaphragm most commonly caused by blunt or penetrating thoracoabdominal trauma, with the left side affected in approximately 75 percent of cases due to the protective effect of the liver on the right. Herniation of abdominal viscera into the thorax may cause respiratory distress, bowel obstruction, or strangulation.

## Diaphysis

The shaft of a long bone, comprising thick cortical (compact) bone surrounding the medullary cavity, which contains bone marrow in children and is largely yellow (fatty) marrow in adults. Enclosed by periosteum; the nutrient artery enters here. Fractures of the diaphysis heal by callus formation (enchondral and intramembranous).

## Diarrhea

Diarrhea is passage of loose or watery stools more frequently than usual; duration, blood, fever, dehydration, exposures, and associated symptoms guide evaluation. medicines, dietary factors, inflammation, malabsorption, or other conditions. Associated symptoms and the need for testing or treatment de-



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pend on severity, duration, and the person's clinical features.

### **Diarrhea, Constipation, Gas, And Bloating**

These common gastrointestinal symptoms arise from disruptions in normal digestive function caused by diet, infections, medications, or underlying conditions like irritable bowel syndrome. Diarrhea involves increased stool frequency and water content, while constipation involves infrequent or difficult passage of stool.

### **Diastasis Recti**

Separation and thinning of the linea alba between the two rectus abdominis muscles, commonly occurring during or after pregnancy. It produces a midline abdominal bulge that becomes prominent with raised intra-abdominal pressure.

### **Diastole**

The phase of the cardiac cycle when the heart muscle relaxes, allowing the chambers to fill with blood.

### **Diastolic Dysfunction**

Impaired relaxation, compliance, or filling of the left or right ventricle during diastole. It can raise filling pressures and cause exertional dyspnoea, pulmonary congestion, or heart failure with preserved ejection fraction; echocardiography assesses relaxation, chamber structure, and estimated filling pressure.

### **Diathermy**

The use of high-frequency electrical current to generate heat for surgical purposes, including cutting tissue, coagulating blood vessels to stop bleeding (hemostasis), and destroying abnormal tissue (electrocautery, electrocoagulation).

### **Diatom Test**

Forensic technique used to support the diagnosis of drowning; microscopic silica-shelled diatoms present in drowning water enter lungs, penetrate alveolar capillaries, and circulate to distant closed organs (femur bone marrow, brain) only if active circulation

was present at time of submersion.

### **Dichorionic Twins**

Twins that each have a separate chorion and amnion. All dizygotic twins are dichorionic, and some monozygotic twins are as well. Each fetus usually has a separate placental circulation, although the placentas may appear fused; complications include preterm birth and growth disturbance.

### **DICOM**

Digital Imaging and Communications in Medicine. Standard for medical image exchange.

### **Dietary Assessment**

The systematic evaluation of a person's food and nutrient intake, using methods such as a food diary, 24-hour recall, or food-frequency questionnaire.

### **Dietary Fat**

A macronutrient composed mainly of triglycerides and fatty acids that provides approximately 9 kcal per gram. Fat supports cell membranes, energy storage, absorption of vitamins A, D, E, and K, and synthesis of signaling molecules; the type of fat affects cardiometabolic risk.

### **Dietary Reference Intakes**

Reference values for nutrient intake: RDA (Recommended Dietary Allowance), AI (Adequate Intake), UL (Tolerable Upper Intake Level), EAR (Estimated Average Requirement).

### **Dieulafoy Lesion**

Large caliber persistent submucosal artery in the stomach wall that can cause massive gastrointestinal bleeding. The artery is abnormally large and superficial, lacking the normal tapering into smaller arterioles. Presents with hematemesis or melena without a visible ulcer.

### **Differential Diagnosis**

The process of distinguishing a particular disease or condition from others that present with similar symptoms. Systematic approach: consider life-



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threatening conditions first, use pretest probability, apply diagnostic criteria, and order targeted tests.

### **Differentiation**

The process by which cells develop specialized structures and functions. In pathology, the term also describes how closely tumor cells resemble the normal tissue from which they arose.

### **Difficult Airway**

A clinical situation in which a trained clinician has difficulty with oxygenation, ventilation, supraglottic airway placement, laryngoscopy, or tracheal intubation. It may result from anatomical features, illness, trauma, or limited equipment and requires an appropriate airway plan.

### **Difficult Intubation**

Difficulty placing an endotracheal tube despite appropriate technique and equipment. Risk may be increased by limited mouth opening or neck movement, abnormal airway anatomy, facial trauma, obesity, or a previous difficult airway. Preparation includes assessment, preoxygenation, and backup airway plans.

### **Diffuse Axonal Injury**

Widespread injury to nerve fibers caused by acceleration or deceleration of the brain. It may produce prolonged impaired consciousness, and MRI can show characteristic lesions.

### **Diffuse Esophageal Spasm**

A motility disorder characterised by premature, uncoordinated esophageal contractions, causing intermittent chest pain and dysphagia for liquids and solids. Endoscopy excludes structural disease; high-resolution manometry confirms premature contractions.

### **Diffusing Capacity**

Ability of lungs to transfer gas from alveoli to blood. Reduced in emphysema, ILD, and anemia. Increased in pulmonary hemorrhage and left-to-right shunts.

### **Diffusing Capacity Of The Lung**

The capacity of the respiratory membrane to transfer gas from alveolar air into pulmonary capillary blood. It depends on surface area, membrane thickness, gas properties, hemoglobin, and pulmonary capillary blood volume and is commonly measured with carbon monoxide as DLCO.

### **Diffusion**

The net movement of molecules from an area of higher concentration to lower concentration due to random thermal motion (Brownian motion).

### **Diffusion Restriction**

Reduced movement of water molecules detected by diffusion-sensitive MRI sequences, usually appearing bright on DWI with corresponding low ADC. It may indicate acute ischemia but can also occur with abscess, hypercellular tumor, seizure, and other processes.

### **Diffusion-Weighted Imaging**

An MRI technique that detects differences in the movement of water molecules within tissue. Restricted diffusion may occur in acute stroke, abscess, hypercellular tumors, and other conditions.

### **DiGeorge Syndrome**

A disorder usually caused by a deletion of part of chromosome 22 that can affect development of the thymus, parathyroid glands, heart, palate, and immune system. It is also called 22q11.2 deletion syndrome.

#### **Synonyms:**

22q11.

### **Digestion**

The process by which the body breaks down ingested food into smaller molecules that can be absorbed and utilized. Digestion begins in the mouth (mechanical–mastication; enzymatic–salivary amylase for starch, lingual lipase).

### **Digestive Health**

The efficient functioning of the gastrointestinal tract

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in breaking down food, absorbing nutrients, and eliminating waste. Digestive health depends on factors such as diet, hydration, gut microbiome balance, and the integrity of the digestive mucosa.

### Digital Clubbing

Bulbous enlargement of distal phalanges with loss of nail-bed angle ( $> 180$  degrees). Associated with lung cancer, ILD, bronchiectasis, and cyanotic heart disease.

### Digital Ischemia

Reduced arterial blood flow to the fingers causing pain, pallor, coolness, and potential tissue necrosis. Causes include Raynaud phenomenon, thromboangiitis obliterans, cholesterol emboli, and arterial thrombosis. Severe cases may require amputation of affected digits.

### Digital Mucous Cyst

A benign ganglion cyst arising from the distal interphalangeal joint, presenting as a translucent, dome-shaped nodule on the dorsal aspect of the finger near the nail fold. It is associated with osteoarthritis of the DIP joint.

### Digital Subtraction Angiography

An imaging technique that subtracts precontrast images from contrast-enhanced images to show blood vessels more clearly. It can also guide selected vascular procedures.

### Digitalis (Digoxin) Toxicity

Nausea, vomiting, visual changes (yellow halos), arrhythmias. Risk: narrow therapeutic index, renal impairment, hypokalemia. Treatment: digoxin immune Fab, cardiac monitoring, correct electrolytes.

#### Synonyms:

Digoxin

### Digitalis Toxicity

Toxicity from digitalis or related cardiac glycosides, causing gastrointestinal symptoms, visual changes, confusion, bradyarrhythmias, tachyarrhythmias, or hyperkalemia. digitoxin) characterized by a narrow therapeutic index (0.5-2.0 ng/mL for digoxin).

### Digoxin Immune Fab

Antibody fragments that bind free digoxin and related cardiac glycosides, reducing their tissue activity. Indications include life-threatening dysrhythmia, severe hyperkalemia from acute toxicity, or a potentially massive ingestion.

### Dilated Cardiomyopathy

A disease of the heart muscle in which one or more chambers enlarge and contract poorly, usually causing reduced ejection fraction. Causes include inherited disease, infection, toxins, medicines, pregnancy, and ischemic or inflammatory injury.

#### Synonyms:

Cardiomyopathy, Dilated

### Dilated Cardiomyopathy Prognosis

Prognosis varies widely and depends on ventricular function, symptoms, cause, arrhythmias, comorbidities, and response to treatment. Guideline-directed therapy can improve cardiac function in some people, while severe disease may lead to heart failure, arrhythmia, or the need for advanced therapies.

### Dilation And Curettage

Surgical dilation of the cervix and curettage (scraping) of the uterine lining. Indications: incomplete or missed abortion (miscarriage management), therapeutic abortion, endometrial sampling (abnormal uterine bleeding, postmenopausal bleeding, endometrial hyperplasia/cancer), and removal of retained products of conception (RPOC).

### Dilator

An instrument or device used to gradually widen a body opening or passage.

### Dilute Russell Viper Venom Time

A phospholipid-dependent clotting assay used mainly to detect lupus anticoagulant. It is commonly performed as part of laboratory evaluation for antiphospholipid syndrome, with confirmatory testing required because anticoagulants and other factor abnormalities can affect the result.

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### **Dimercaprol**

Chelating agent for arsenic, mercury, gold. Given IM. Side effects: hypertension, tachycardia, nausea, pain at injection site.

### **Dinoprostone (Cervidil, Prepidil)**

A prostaglandin E2 medicine used to soften the cervix and help initiate labor. It is available in several formulations, and administration requires obstetric monitoring because it can cause excessive uterine activity or fetal effects.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cervidil, Prepidil

### **Dipeptidyl Peptidase-4 Inhibitors**

Oral glucose-lowering medications including sitagliptin, saxagliptin, linagliptin, and alogliptin that inhibit the enzyme degrading incretin hormones GLP-1 and GIP. Resulting increase in active incretin levels enhances glucose-dependent insulin secretion and suppresses glucagon. Neutral effect on weight and low hypoglycemia risk.

### **Diphtheria**

Diphtheria is a toxin-producing *Corynebacterium* infection that can form a pharyngeal pseudomembrane and cause airway obstruction, myocarditis, and neuropathy. gram-positive aerobic bacillus that produces a potent exotoxin that inhibits protein synthesis via ADP-ribosylation of elongation factor 2, causing local tissue necrosis and systemic toxicity.

### **Diphtheria Vaccine**

Toxoid vaccine containing formalin-inactivated diphtheria toxin, providing immunity against the exotoxin produced by *Corynebacterium diphtheriae* rather than the bacterium itself.

### **Dipyllobothrium Latum**

The fish tapeworm, a large cestode infecting humans through consumption of raw or undercooked freshwater fish. It can grow up to 10 meters in length and absorbs vitamin B12 in the intestine, potentially causing megaloblastic anemia. Diagnosis is by identification of eggs or proglottids in stool. Treatment is with praziquantel.

### **Diplopia**

Double vision, in which one object is perceived as two. It may result from ocular misalignment, nerve disease, muscle disease, or a brain disorder.

### **Diplopia (Double Vision)**

The perception of two images of a single object, classified by onset, duration, and whether it resolves with covering one eye. Monocular diplopia (persists with one eye covered): caused by ocular surface abnormalities (dry eye, irregular astigmatism, cataract, corneal scar, lens dislocation)—usually benign.

#### **Synonyms:**

Double Vision

### **Direct Antiglobulin Test**

An immunohematologic test that detects immunoglobulin and/or complement bound to the surface of a patient's erythrocytes. A positive result supports in-vivo red-cell coating, as in autoimmune hemolytic anemia, hemolytic transfusion reactions, and hemolytic disease of the fetus and newborn.

### **Direct Coombs Test**

Direct antiglobulin test: detects antibodies or complement (C3) bound to the surface of RBCs in vivo. Positive in: autoimmune hemolytic anemia (warm: IgG, cold: C3), drug-induced hemolytic anemia, hemolytic transfusion reaction, and hemolytic disease of the newborn (HDN). Grading: 1+ to 4+.

### **Direct Oral Anticoagulants**

DOACs directly inhibit specific coagulation factors. Direct thrombin inhibitors: dabigatran. Factor Xa inhibitors: rivaroxaban, apixaban, edoxaban, betrixaban. They have predictable pharmacokinetics, fixed dosing, and routine monitoring is not required. They have fewer drug interactions than warfarin.

### **Direct Veneer**

Composite restoration placed chairside for aesthetic improvement. Conservative alternative to laboratory veneer.

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### **Directly Observed Therapy**

Supervision of medication ingestion to ensure adherence. Standard of care for TB treatment. Ensures completion of the full treatment course and reduces development of drug resistance.

### **Dirofilaria Repens**

A filarial nematode transmitted by mosquitoes that causes subcutaneous or ocular dirofilariasis in humans, an accidental dead-end host. It presents as a solitary, migratory subcutaneous nodule, often on the trunk or extremities, or as a conjunctival or periorbital mass.

### **Disability**

A limitation in body function or structure, activity, or participation that results from a health condition and interaction with the person's environment.

### **Disability Evaluation**

Assessment of functional limitations for legal, insurance, or benefits purposes. Objective measures, standardized tests.

### **Disability-Adjusted Life Year**

A population-health measure combining years of life lost because of premature mortality with years lived with disability. One DALY represents one lost year of healthy life under the chosen methods and disability weights.

### **Disaster Preparedness**

Planning and organizing resources, training, and procedures to reduce harm and support effective response and recovery during disasters.

### **Discectomy**

Surgical removal of a herniated intervertebral disc fragment compressing a nerve root. Microscopic discectomy (most common): small incision, microscope, minimal muscle dissection.

### **Discharge Planning**

A multidisciplinary process that prepares a patient for safe transition from hospital or facility care to

the next setting. It includes medication review, follow-up, education, equipment, self-management support, and communication of pending results.

### **Discitis**

Inflammation or infection of an intervertebral disc, often involving adjacent vertebral endplates. It may cause severe localized back or neck pain, stiffness, fever, and reduced mobility; causes include haematogenous infection, postoperative infection, and inflammatory disease, with MRI being the preferred imaging study.

### **Discography**

An imaging procedure in which contrast material is injected into an intervertebral disc to assess disc structure and reproduce pain. Its diagnostic value is limited and its use is selective.

### **Disease**

Abnormal condition affecting body. Can be infectious, degenerative, neoplastic, etc.

### **Disease Reporting**

Mandatory notification of specified diseases or health events to public-health authorities.

### **Disease-Free Survival**

The length of time after treatment during which a patient remains alive without detectable evidence of the disease. The precise definition depends on the cancer and the study protocol.

### **Disease-Modifying Antirheumatic Drug**

A medication that reduces inflammatory disease activity and helps prevent structural damage or disability rather than providing only symptomatic relief. Conventional synthetic, biologic, and targeted synthetic DMARDs are used according to disease and patient factors.

### **Disinfection**

The elimination of most pathogenic microorganisms on inanimate surfaces. Disinfection does not eliminate all forms of microbial life, particularly spores.

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High-level disinfection eliminates all microorganisms except spores. Intermediate-level disinfection eliminates mycobacteria, most viruses, and bacteria.

### **Disk Diffusion Susceptibility Test**

A standardized method in which antimicrobial-impregnated disks are placed on an inoculated agar surface and zones of growth inhibition are measured. Zone diameters are interpreted using validated organism- and drug-specific breakpoints.

### **Diskectomy**

A surgical procedure that removes part or all of a spinal disc to relieve pressure on a spinal nerve or the spinal cord, causing radiculopathy or myelopathy. Indicated in severe disk herniation causing unremitting pain, progressive motor weakness, or cauda equina syndrome.

### **Diskitis**

Inflammation or infection of an intervertebral disc and adjacent vertebral endplates, often causing severe localized back pain and sometimes fever. usually caused by bacterial infection. It causes localized back pain, stiffness, fever, and reluctance to move, particularly in children.

### **Dislocation**

Complete loss of normal contact between the surfaces of a joint, usually caused by trauma or structural disease and potentially accompanied by fracture, nerve, or blood-vessel injury.

### **Dislocation Of The Lens**

Partial or complete displacement of the crystalline lens from its normal position within the pupillary axis due to disruption or weakness of the zonular fibers. Causes include Marfan syndrome, homocystinuria, trauma, and prior intraocular surgery; it may cause acute angle-closure glaucoma or blurred vision.

### **Disofenin Scan**

Hepatobiliary imaging using Tc-99m disofenin. Similar to mebrofenin scan.

### **Disorder**

A disturbance of normal structure or function that causes symptoms, impairment, or clinically important risk. The term does not necessarily indicate a particular level of severity.

### **Disorientation**

Difficulty knowing one's time, place, situation, or identity. It may occur with delirium, infection, metabolic disturbances, intoxication or withdrawal, brain injury, or dementia. Sudden disorientation is an urgent medical symptom.

### **Dissection**

A tear in the inner layer of a blood vessel that allows blood to track between the vessel-wall layers and create a false channel. In the aorta, this is called aortic dissection.

### **Disseminated Coccidioidomycosis**

Coccidioides infection that spreads beyond the lungs to skin, bone, meninges, or other organs.

### **Disseminated Cutaneous Blastomycosis**

Blastomyces infection involving multiple areas of skin, usually after spread from a pulmonary infection.

### **Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation**

A pathological state of simultaneous systemic activation of coagulation and fibrinolysis, leading to widespread microvascular thrombosis that causes organ ischemia and dysfunction, paradoxically accompanied by consumptive coagulopathy and increased bleeding risk.

### **Disseminated Mycobacterium Avium–Intracellulare Infection**

Widespread infection with Mycobacterium avium complex, usually occurring in people with severe immune suppression.

### **Disseminated Varicella Infection**

Varicella-zoster virus infection that spreads beyond the skin and may involve the lungs, brain, liver, or



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other organs.

### **Dissociation**

A disruption in the normal integration of consciousness, memory, identity, emotion, perception, behavior, and sense of self. It exists on a spectrum from normal (daydreaming) to pathological (DID, depersonalization-derealization).

### **Dissociative Amnesia**

Inability to recall important autobiographical information, usually of a traumatic or stressful nature, that is inconsistent with ordinary forgetting. The amnesia may be localized, selective, generalized, or continuous.

### **Dissociative Disorder**

DSM-5 category comprising disruption of the normally integrated functions of consciousness, memory, identity, perception, and behaviour, including dissociative amnesia, dissociative identity disorder, and depersonalization-derealization disorder. Strongly associated with severe early-life trauma.

### **Dissociative Identity Disorder**

The presence of two or more distinct personality states or an experience of possession involving marked discontinuity in sense of self, agency, affect, behavior, memory, perception, cognition, and/or sensory-motor functioning.

### **Distal**

Farther from the point of attachment or origin of a structure, or farther from the centre of the body; the opposite directional term is proximal.

### **Distal Radius Fractures**

The most common upper extremity fracture. Classification: AO/OTA: A (extra-articular), B (partial articular), C (complete articular); Frykman. Colles fracture: dorsal angulation/displacement (fall on outstretched hand). Smith fracture: volar angulation (fall on flexed wrist).

### **Distal Tubule**

Segment of the nephron extending from the thick ascending limb of the loop of Henle to the collecting duct. The early distal tubule reabsorbs sodium and chloride through the NCC cotransporter, which is the target of thiazide diuretics.

### **Distraction Osteogenesis**

Surgical bone lengthening by gradual distraction. Used for jaw deformities, trauma.

### **Distributive Shock**

Shock caused by pathologic vasodilation and maldistribution of blood flow, producing inadequate effective circulating volume despite variable cardiac output. Causes include sepsis, anaphylaxis, neurogenic shock, and some toxic syndromes.

### **Diuresis**

Increased urine production. Can be physiological (fluid overload) or pharmacological (diuretics). Osmotic diuresis (hyperglycemia), water diuresis (DI), saline diuresis (hypertonic saline).

### **Diuretic**

A drug that increases urine production, used for edema (heart failure, cirrhosis, renal disease), hypertension, and electrolyte disorders.

### **Diverticular Disease**

Condition characterized by the presence of diverticula, which are outpouchings of the colonic mucosa and submucosa through defects in the muscularis propria at sites where vasa recta penetrate the bowel wall.

### **Diverticulitis**

Diverticulitis is inflammation or infection of a diverticulum, usually in the colon, causing localized abdominal pain, fever, altered bowel habits, or complications such as abscess. diverticulosis affecting 10-25 percent of individuals with diverticula. The pathophysiology involves microperforation of a diverticulum with fecal contents entering the pericolic tissues, inciting inflammation and potential abscess formation.



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## Diverticulosis

The presence of diverticula, usually small pouches in the colon wall; it may be asymptomatic or cause bleeding and can coexist with diverticulitis.

### Synonyms:

Colonic Diverticulitis (Diverticulosis) Diverticula (Diverticulosis)

## Diverticula (Diverticulosis)

Alternate index label; see *Diverticulosis*. sites of vascular penetration, most commonly in the sigmoid colon (90 percent of cases). Prevalence increases with age, affecting over 50 percent of individuals older than 60 years and nearly 70 percent by age 85.

## Diverticulosis And Diverticulitis

Diverticulosis is a condition in which small, bulging pouches (diverticula) form in the lining of the digestive tract, most commonly in the colon. Diverticulitis occurs when these pouches become inflamed or infected, causing abdominal pain, fever, and changes in bowel habits.

## Dix-Hallpike Maneuver

The Dix-Hallpike maneuver is a diagnostic test used to identify benign paroxysmal positional vertigo by detecting the characteristic nystagmus and vertigo that occur when displaced otoconia within the posterior semicircular canal move in response to gravity during specific head positioning.

## Dizziness

Dizziness is a subjective sensation that may represent vertigo, lightheadedness, imbalance, or nonspecific disequilibrium; history and examination distinguish vestibular, cardiovascular, neurologic, and other causes. include disorders of the vestibular system, cardiovascular system, nervous system, vision, medications, or metabolism.

## DMFT Index

An epidemiologic index recording the number of permanent teeth that are decayed, missing because of caries, or filled. It estimates cumulative caries experience but does not measure current lesion activity

or distinguish all causes of tooth loss.

## DMSA Scan

A nuclear-medicine study using technetium-labeled dimercaptosuccinic acid to show renal cortical function and areas of cortical injury or scarring.

## DNA

Deoxyribonucleic acid, the hereditary material in humans and most organisms. Double helix of two antiparallel strands (sugar-phosphate backbone, nitrogenous bases: A-T, G-C). Human genome: 3 billion base pairs, 20,000 protein-coding genes.

## DNA (Deoxyribonucleic Acid)

Double-stranded helical molecule carrying genetic information. Composed of nucleotides (sugar-phosphate backbone with bases adenine, thymine, guanine, cytosine). Replication is semi-conservative. Genes are specific sequences encoding proteins or functional RNAs. Chromosomes are highly condensed DNA-protein complexes.

### Synonyms:

Deoxyribonucleic Acid

## DNA Double Helix

The molecular structure of DNA described by Watson and Crick in 1953, consisting of two antiparallel polynucleotide chains wound around each other in a right-handed helix. The sugar-phosphate backbone is on the exterior; nitrogenous bases project inward.

## DNA Profiling

Analysis of polymorphic DNA markers, commonly short tandem repeats, to compare biological samples for human identification or kinship assessment. Results are statistical associations and require validated laboratory procedures, appropriate controls, and documented sample integrity.

## DNA Repair

The cellular processes that detect and correct damage or copying errors in DNA. Major pathways include base-excision, nucleotide-excision, mismatch, and double-strand-break repair.

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## DNA Repair Mechanisms

Cellular processes that correct DNA damage caused by replication errors, chemicals, radiation, and reactive oxygen species. Mismatch repair (MMR): corrects base-base mismatches and insertion-deletion loops that escape proofreading during replication.

## DNA Replication

The semi-conservative process by which DNA duplicates before cell division, producing two identical daughter molecules each containing one original and one new strand.

## DNA Sequencing

Determination of the nucleotide order in DNA. Sanger sequencing uses chain termination and is useful for selected small targets. Next-generation sequencing (NGS) uses massively parallel sequencing, whole genome, whole exome, targeted panels.

## Do Not Resuscitate

DNR: order not to perform CPR. Can be combined with DNI (do not intubate).

## DOACs

Direct oral anticoagulants are a class of anticoagulant drugs that directly inhibit specific coagulation factors, providing an alternative to warfarin with more predictable pharmacokinetics and no routine monitoring.

## Dobutamine Stress Echocardiography

Pharmacological stress test using dobutamine (beta-1 agonist) to increase heart rate, contractility, and myocardial oxygen demand. New or worsening wall motion abnormalities indicate ischemia. Preferred when patients cannot exercise. Beta-blockers should be held before testing.

## Docusate

A stool softener (surfactant laxative) that increases water and fat incorporation into stool by lowering surface tension, facilitating defecation in patients who should avoid straining (post-MI, post-surgery, hemorrhoids) and for opioid-related constipation. Onset 12-72 hours.

## Domestic Violence

A pattern of coercive control and physical, sexual, psychological, or economic abuse by one intimate partner or household member against another. Forensic evaluation documents patterned injuries, defensive wounds, strangulation signs, burns, and injuries of differing ages.

## Dominant

Allele whose phenotype is expressed in heterozygotes. Autosomal dominant disorders: Huntington disease, marfan syndrome, achondroplasia. Requires only one copy for expression.

## Donor Insemination

A fertility treatment in which sperm from a donor (anonymous or known) is placed into a woman's vagina, cervix, or uterus to achieve pregnancy. Indications: male factor infertility (azoospermia, severe oligospermia), genetic disorders in the male partner, single women, and same-sex female couples.

## Donor Suitability Assessment

Comprehensive evaluation of a potential organ donor including medical history, laboratory testing, and organ function assessment to determine transplant eligibility.

## Donor Testing

Laboratory and clinical evaluation of potential organ donors for infectious diseases, malignancy, and organ function.

## Donovanosis

A chronic, progressive, ulcerative genital infection caused by the intracellular gram-negative bacterium *Klebsiella granulomatis* (formerly *Calymmatobacterium granulomatis*). Also known as granuloma inguinale.

### Synonyms:

granuloma inguinale.

## Dopamine Agonist

A class of medications that stimulate dopamine receptors (D1-D5), mimicking the effects of endoge-

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nous dopamine.

### **Doppler Ultrasound**

Ultrasound technique using the Doppler effect to evaluate blood flow. Color Doppler: direction and velocity of flow (red = toward transducer, blue = away). Spectral Doppler: waveform analysis (arterial: pulsatile; venous: continuous). Pulsed-wave: measures flow at a specific depth.

### **Doppler Velocimetry**

Ultrasound measuring blood flow velocity in umbilical and fetal vessels. Assesses fetal well-being.

### **Doravirine**

A non-nucleoside reverse transcriptase inhibitor (NNRTI) used in combination antiretroviral therapy for HIV-1 infection. Doravirine binds to the HIV reverse transcriptase enzyme and inhibits its activity through a unique mechanism that maintains activity against strains resistant to first-generation NNRTIs.

### **Dorsal**

Relating to the back side of the body; synonym for posterior in human anatomy.

### **Dorsal Root Ganglion**

A swelling on the dorsal root of a spinal nerve containing the cell bodies of primary sensory neurons. Its pseudounipolar neurons convey peripheral sensory information to the spinal cord.

### **Dosage**

The amount and frequency of a drug administered to achieve a therapeutic effect while minimizing toxicity. Components: dose (amount, e.g., mg), dosing interval (frequency), route, and duration.

### **Dose**

Amount of substance administered. Factors: weight, age, renal/hepatic function, drug interactions. Toxic dose varies by substance and individual.

### **Dose-Limiting Toxicity**

An adverse effect of an anticancer treatment severe

enough to prevent further dose escalation or require dose reduction according to a predefined protocol. DLTs are used in early-phase clinical trials to estimate a tolerable dose.

### **Dose-Response Curve**

A graphical representation of the relationship between the dose of a drug and the magnitude of its biological effect. The x-axis represents dose (typically on a logarithmic scale), and the y-axis represents the response (as percentage of maximum effect).

### **Dose-Response Relationship**

The dose-response relationship describes the quantitative relationship between the dose of a drug and the magnitude of the pharmacological response it produces. This relationship is typically represented as a sigmoidal curve when response is plotted against the log of the dose.

### **Dosimetry**

Measurement and calculation of radiation dose. Patient dosimetry for therapy.

### **DOTATATE**

Somatostatin analog labeled with Ga-68 for PET imaging of neuroendocrine tumors.

### **Double Outlet Right Ventricle**

A congenital heart defect where more than 50% of both great arteries arise from the right ventricle, with a VSD as the only outlet from the left ventricle.

### **Double-Balloon Enteroscopy**

Advanced endoscopic technique using an enteroscope equipped with balloons at the tip of both the endoscope and an overtube allowing systematic advancement and visualization of the entire small bowel. The balloons are alternately inflated and deflated to anchor the bowel wall and advance the endoscope.

### **Douche**

A stream of water or solution directed into a body cavity, most commonly the vagina, for cleansing,

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therapeutic, or contraceptive purposes.

### **Down Syndrome**

Trisomy 21, most common viable trisomy. Features: intellectual disability, characteristic facies (flat face, upslanting palpebral fissures), hypotonia, heart defects, increased risk of leukemia, Alzheimer disease. Maternal age is major risk factor.

#### **Synonyms:**

Trisomy 21 Syndrome

### **DPP-4 Inhibitors**

Dipeptidyl peptidase-4 inhibitors that prevent degradation of endogenous GLP-1 and GIP, enhancing incretin effects on insulin secretion. Examples include sitagliptin, saxagliptin, linagliptin, and alogliptin. They are well-tolerated with low hypoglycemia risk and weight neutrality. They have modest glucose-lowering effects.

### **Drain (Surgical)**

Tube for fluid evacuation. Types: closed suction (Jackson-Pratt, Hemovac), open (Penrose), pigtail. Indications: abscess, hematoma, seroma, biliary, urinary. Complications: infection, blockage, migration.

#### **Synonyms:**

Surgical

### **Drainage Procedures**

Image-guided drainage of fluid collections. Abscess, hematoma, biloma, urinoma. CT or ultrasound guidance.

### **Dreams (Geriatric)**

Sleep disturbances common. Nightmares, insomnia. Evaluate for delirium, depression, medications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **DRESS Syndrome**

Drug Reaction with Eosinophilia and Systemic Symptoms, a severe, potentially life-threatening adverse drug reaction. Typically occurs 2-8 weeks after drug initiation (latency longer than SJS/TEN).

Causative drugs: anticonvulsants (phenytoin, carbamazepine, lamotrigine), allopurinol, sulfonamides, dapsone, minocycline.

### **Dressler Syndrome**

A delayed pericarditis occurring 2-10 weeks after myocardial infarction or cardiac surgery. It is an autoimmune-mediated inflammation caused by antibodies against myocardial antigens released during tissue injury. Symptoms include fever, pleuritic chest pain, and pericardial friction rub. ECG may show diffuse ST elevation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Post-Cardiac Injury Syndrome Postmyocardial Infarction Syndrome

### **Drift (Sit-To-Stand)**

A functional assessment of lower-limb strength, balance, and mobility. Timed sit-to-stand, chair-rise, and timed-up-and-go tests may be used; results are interpreted according to the person's age, baseline function, assistive devices, and clinical purpose.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sit-to-Stand

### **Driving Evaluation**

Assess driving fitness after neurological, musculoskeletal conditions. On-road testing, vehicle modifications.

### **Driving Rehabilitation**

Training for adaptive driving: hand controls, left-foot accelerator, other modifications.

### **Drooling**

Unintentional escape of saliva from the mouth caused by excess production, impaired swallowing, poor lip closure, or neurologic and developmental disorders.

### **Droplet Precautions**

Infection control measures used for pathogens transmitted through respiratory droplets. Precautions include surgical masks, patient placement in single rooms, and spatial separation. Droplet precautions

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are used for influenza, pertussis, and meningococcal infections. The distance for spatial separation is typically 3-6 feet.

### **Drowning**

Respiratory impairment from submersion/immersion in liquid. Drowning can be fatal or non-fatal. Pathophysiology: laryngospasm followed by aspiration of fluid, surfactant washout, pulmonary edema, and hypoxemia. Fresh water: washes out surfactant, causes alveolar collapse. Salt water: draws fluid into alveoli (pulmonary edema).

#### **Synonyms:**

Wet Dry Drowning (Drowning)

### **Drowning (Dry/Wet Signs)**

Respiratory impairment caused by submersion or immersion in liquid. So-called dry and wet signs are unreliable for determining the cause of death.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dry/Wet Signs

### **Drowsiness**

An abnormally strong tendency to fall asleep or reduced alertness, caused by insufficient sleep, medicines, substances, metabolic illness, sleep disorders, or neurologic disease.

### **Drug Allergy**

An adverse immune-mediated reaction to a medication, representing a hypersensitivity response that is distinct from side effects, toxicities, and idiosyncratic reactions.

### **Drug Antagonism**

An interaction where one drug blocks or decreases the effectiveness of another, such as when an antidote blocks a poison.

### **Drug Bioavailability**

The fraction of an administered drug that reaches systemic circulation unchanged. Oral bioavailability is affected by first-pass metabolism, absorption, and drug formulation. IV administration has 100% bioavailability. Bioavailability influences drug dos-

ing and route selection.

### **Drug Classification Systems**

Systems that group medicines according to properties such as their chemical structure, mechanism of action, therapeutic use, or effects on the body.

### **Drug Clearance**

The volume of plasma completely cleared of drug per unit time. Hepatic clearance depends on hepatic blood flow and enzyme activity; renal clearance depends on glomerular filtration, tubular secretion, and reabsorption. Total clearance determines maintenance dose.

### **Drug Dependence**

A state of physiological or psychological adaptation to a drug, characterized by a withdrawal syndrome upon discontinuation or dose reduction. Physical dependence: the body has adapted to the presence of the drug, and abrupt cessation produces a predictable withdrawal syndrome specific to the drug class.

### **Drug Hypersensitivity Reactions**

Immune-mediated adverse reactions to medicines. They may be immediate or delayed and can range from a mild rash to severe systemic illness.

### **Drug Hypersensitivity Syndrome**

A severe delayed drug reaction occurring 2 to 8 weeks after drug initiation. It presents with fever, rash (morbilliform, facial edema, exfoliative dermatitis), lymphadenopathy, eosinophilia, and internal organ involvement (hepatitis most common, also nephritis, pneumonitis, myocarditis).

### **Drug Interaction**

A change in the effect or concentration of one medicine caused by another medicine, food, substance, or disease.

### **Drug Metabolism Pharmacogenomics**

Pharmacogenomics of drug metabolism examines how genetic variations affect individual responses to

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drugs, enabling personalized medicine approaches to prescribing.

### **Drug Overdose**

Excessive ingestion of medication. Common: opioids, benzodiazepines, acetaminophen, salicylates, tricyclic antidepressants. Management: ABCs, activated charcoal, specific antidotes (naloxone, flumazenil, N-acetylcysteine), supportive care.

### **Drug Overdose Management**

Management of poisoning begins with assessment and support of airway, breathing, circulation, and neurologic status. Decontamination, enhanced elimination, and specific antidotes are considered only when appropriate for the substance, timing, and patient.

### **Drug Reaction With Eosinophilia And Systemic Symptoms**

A severe hypersensitivity syndrome characterized by fever, rash, lymphadenopathy, and multiorgan involvement triggered by medications, requiring prompt drug cessation and systemic corticosteroids.

### **Drug Resistance**

The ability of microorganisms, cancer cells, or parasites to survive and proliferate despite exposure to drugs that were previously effective.

### **Drug Screening**

Urine, blood, hair testing for substances of abuse. Panels: opiates, cocaine, amphetamines, cannabinoids, PCP, benzodiazepines, barbiturates. False positives possible. Confirmation by GC/MS or LC-MS/MS.

### **Drug Testing**

Laboratory analysis of biological specimens to detect drugs, metabolites, or poisons, used in clinical, workplace, sports, and forensic contexts. Specimens include blood, urine, oral fluid, hair, and postmortem tissues.

### **Drug Therapeutics**

The use of medicines to prevent, diagnose, or treat disease while balancing expected benefit and potential harm.

### **Drug Tolerance**

A decreased pharmacological response to a drug after repeated administration, requiring dose escalation to achieve the same effect.

### **Drug Toxicity**

Harmful effects caused by a medicine or its metabolites. Toxicity may result from excessive exposure, accumulation, interactions, or an unpredictable individual reaction.

### **Drug Withdrawal**

A clinically significant syndrome or return of symptoms caused by abrupt reduction or cessation of a drug after physiologic adaptation or dependence has developed. Tapering is required for some medications to reduce withdrawal and rebound effects.

### **Drug-Drug Interactions**

When one drug alters the pharmacokinetics or pharmacodynamics of another. Pharmacokinetic interactions affect absorption, distribution, metabolism, or excretion (e.g., CYP inhibitors increasing warfarin levels).

### **Drug-Eluting Balloon (Vascular)**

A vascular balloon catheter that delivers a medicine to the vessel wall during dilation, without leaving a permanent implant.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Drug-Eluting Stent**

A vascular stent that slowly releases a medicine to reduce tissue growth and the risk of restenosis after angioplasty.

### **Drug-Eluting Stent (Vascular)**

A vascular stent coated with medicine that is released gradually to reduce tissue growth and recur-



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rent narrowing.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Drug-Facilitated Sexual Assault**

Sexual contact occurring when a person's capacity to consent or resist is impaired by alcohol, medication, or another drug, whether administered covertly or knowingly consumed. Medical care includes urgent safety assessment, treatment of injuries, toxicology sampling when indicated, prophylaxis, and trauma-informed support.

### **Drug-Induced Autoimmunity**

Drug-induced lupus (DIL): procainamide, hydralazine, isoniazid, minocycline, TNF inhibitors, anti-TNF; anti-histone antibodies, positive ANA, negative anti-dsDNA/anti-Sm; symptoms resolve after drug cessation.

### **Drug-Induced Liver Injury**

Liver damage caused by a medicine, herbal product, or dietary supplement. It may produce abnormal liver tests, hepatitis, cholestasis, or liver failure; evaluation requires considering the exposure, timing, competing causes, and severity.

### **Drusen**

Yellowish-white deposits of extracellular material that accumulate beneath the retinal pigment epithelium between the retinal pigment epithelium basement membrane and Bruch membrane, and they are the hallmark clinical finding in dry age-related macular degeneration.

### **Dry Eye Disease**

Dry eye disease, also known as keratoconjunctivitis sicca, is a multifactorial disorder of the ocular surface characterized by loss of homeostasis of the tear film, resulting in symptoms of ocular discomfort, visual disturbance, and tear film instability, with potential damage to the ocular surface.

**Synonyms:**

keratoconjunctivitis sicca, is a multifactorial disorder.

### **Dry Eye Syndrome**

A multifactorial disease of the ocular surface characterized by tear film instability, hyperosmolarity, and inflammation. Aqueous-deficient dry eye: Sjogren syndrome (autoimmune), non-Sjogren (lacrimal gland dysfunction, age). Evaporative dry eye: meibomian gland dysfunction (most common), incomplete blink, environmental factors.

### **Dry Powder Inhaler**

A breath-actuated inhaler delivering powdered medication. Does not require hand-breath coordination. Requires adequate inspiratory flow. Examples include Advair Diskus and Spiriva HandiHaler.

### **Dry Skin**

Abnormally dry, rough, or scaly skin caused by reduced moisture and disruption of the skin barrier. It is common with aging, low humidity, frequent washing, and eczema and may cause itching or fissuring.

### **Dry Socket (Alveolar Osteitis)**

A painful postoperative complication of tooth extraction, most commonly occurring after the removal of mandibular third molars (wisdom teeth). It is caused by the premature dissolution or loss of the blood clot in the extraction socket, exposing the underlying alveolar bone and nerve endings to the oral cavity.

**Synonyms:**

Alveolar Osteitis

### **DTaP Vaccine**

Diphtheria, Tetanus, and acellular Pertussis vaccine given at 2, 4, 6, and 15-18 months, and 4-6 years. Protects against three serious bacterial diseases. Diphtheria causes respiratory and cardiac complications. Tetanus causes lockjaw and muscle rigidity. Pertussis causes whooping cough, most severe in young infants.

### **Dual Antiplatelet Therapy**

The combination of aspirin and a P2Y<sub>12</sub> inhibitor (clopidogrel, prasugrel, or ticagrelor) for prevention of thrombotic events after acute coronary syndrome

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and percutaneous coronary intervention. Duration varies: 1 month after bare-metal stent, 6-12 months after drug-eluting stent, and 12 months after ACS.

### **Dual-Energy CT**

CT using two different energy spectra. Material differentiation, virtual non-contrast images, gout detection.

### **Dubin-Johnson Syndrome**

An inherited disorder of bilirubin excretion causing predominantly conjugated hyperbilirubinemia and intermittent mild jaundice, usually without major liver dysfunction. mutations in the ABCC2 gene encoding the multidrug resistance-associated protein 2 (MRP2), which transports conjugated bilirubin from hepatocytes into bile.

### **Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy**

An X-linked recessive neuromuscular disorder caused by mutations in the dystrophin gene (DMD gene) on chromosome Xp21.2, resulting in absent or severely reduced dystrophin protein, which is essential for maintaining the structural integrity of the sarcolemma during muscle contraction.

### **Ductal-Dependent Lesions**

Congenital heart defects that require the ductus arteriosus to remain patent for adequate systemic or pulmonary blood flow. Includes pulmonary atresia, critical aortic stenosis, coarctation, hypoplastic left heart syndrome, and transposition of the great arteries.

### **Ductus Arteriosus**

A fetal blood vessel connecting the pulmonary artery to the descending aorta, allowing blood to bypass the non-functioning fetal lungs. In utero, the ductus arteriosus is kept patent by prostaglandin E2 and low oxygen tension.

### **Dumping Syndrome**

Rapid gastric emptying of hypertonic contents into the small bowel after gastrectomy or gastric bypass surgery. Early dumping occurs within thirty minutes with vasomotor symptoms including flushing,

palpitations, diarrhea, and dizziness from fluid shifts into the intestinal lumen.

### **Duodenal Atresia**

A congenital obstruction of the duodenum caused by failure of recanalization during the 8th-10th week of gestation. Associated with Down syndrome (30%), polyhydramnios (due to impaired fetal swallowing of amniotic fluid), and other anomalies (VACTERL, congenital heart disease, annular pancreas, malrotation).

### **Duodenal Perforation**

Full-thickness breach of the duodenal wall, most commonly caused by penetrating peptic ulcer disease, trauma, or iatrogenic injury during endoscopy. Presents with sudden severe epigastric pain, board-like abdominal rigidity, and peritonitis. Free air under the diaphragm on upright chest radiograph is diagnostic.

### **Duodenal Ulcer**

Peptic ulcer in the duodenal mucosa strongly associated with *H. pylori* infection. Presents with epigastric pain relieved by food typically occurring several hours after meals and at night. Complications include hemorrhage, perforation, and gastric outlet obstruction. Diagnosis is by upper endoscopy.

### **Duodenitis**

Inflammation of the duodenal mucosa, caused by *Helicobacter pylori* infection, acid-related disease, non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, infection, coeliac disease, or inflammatory bowel disease. Symptoms may include epigastric pain, nausea, vomiting, and gastrointestinal bleeding.

### **Duodenum**

The first part of the small intestine, extending from the pylorus to the jejunum; it receives bile and pancreatic secretions and is a common site of peptic ulcer disease.

### **Duplex Surveillance**

Scheduled clinical and ultrasound monitoring of an artery, vein, graft, stent, aneurysm, or dialysis

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access to detect restenosis, thrombosis, endoleak, or other failure before symptoms or limb threat develop.

### **Duplex Ultrasound**

An ultrasound examination that combines grayscale imaging of anatomy with Doppler assessment of blood flow. It can evaluate vessels, organs, and selected soft tissues.

### **Duplication**

Presence of extra copy of chromosomal segment. Can cause gene dosage effects. Examples: Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease type 1A (PMP22 duplication).

### **Dupuyten's Contracture**

A fibrosing disorder of the palm that causes progressive flexion contractures of one or more fingers.

### **Dupuytren Contracture**

Dupuytren contracture is progressive shortening of palmar fascia that pulls one or more fingers into flexion and can limit hand function. cords, and contractures of the fingers, most commonly affecting the ring and small fingers.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dupuytren's Contracture (Dupuytren Contracture)

### **Dura Mater**

The outermost, thickest meningeal layer, a tough fibrous membrane. In the cranium it is two layers: periosteal (outer, adherent to skull) and meningeal (inner), which separate to form dural venous sinuses (e.g., superior sagittal, cavernous). Dural folds: falx cerebri, tentorium cerebelli, falx cerebelli.

### **Durable Power Of Attorney**

A legal authorization allowing a designated person to act or make decisions for another person when specified conditions are met. In healthcare, it may appoint a healthcare proxy.

### **Dural Venous Sinuses**

Venous channels between dural layers, draining brain blood and CSF from the subarachnoid space

into the internal jugular veins. Major sinuses: superior sagittal, transverse, sigmoid, cavernous, straight. Valveless with bidirectional flow possible.

### **DVT**

Deep venous thrombosis, the formation of a blood clot in a deep vein, most commonly in the lower extremities.

### **DVT Prevention**

Measures used to reduce the risk of deep venous thrombosis, such as early movement, mechanical compression, and anticoagulant medicine when clinically appropriate.

### **Dwarfism**

Short stature resulting from a medical condition, most commonly achondroplasia (the most common form of skeletal dysplasia, caused by gain-of-function mutation in FGFR3, presenting with rhizomelic limb shortening, macrocephaly, frontal bossing, and trident hands).

### **DWI FLAIR Mismatch**

Diffusion-weighted imaging (DWI) and fluid-attenuated inversion recovery (FLAIR) MRI sequences are used together to estimate the age of an ischemic stroke lesion and guide treatment decisions.

### **Dx**

A common abbreviation for diagnosis or diagnostic assessment.

### **DXA Scan (Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry)**

An imaging test that estimates bone mineral density, commonly at the lumbar spine and hip. It is used to assess fracture risk and osteoporosis. T-scores are generally used for postmenopausal women and older men, whereas Z-scores and clinical context are important in younger people.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dual-Energy X-ray Absorptiometry

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## Dying

The process of progressive physical decline that occurs as a person approaches death, often accompanied by psychological, social, and spiritual changes.

## Dysarthria

Impaired clarity, strength, or coordination of speech caused by dysfunction of the muscles or nervous pathways used for speaking. components of speech production, including the lips, tongue, palate, vocal cords, and respiratory muscles.

## Dysautonomia

Dysfunction of the autonomic nervous system that can affect blood pressure, heart rate, sweating, temperature regulation, digestion, bladder function, or sexual function. It may be primary or secondary to another disease, medication, or injury.

## Dysbiosis

An alteration in microbiome composition, diversity, or function relative to a healthy state, permitting overgrowth of pathobionts or loss of beneficial microbes. Causes include antibiotics, dietary change, stress, and infection. It is associated with inflammatory bowel disease, obesity, allergy, and *Clostridioides difficile* colitis.

## Dyscalculia

A persistent difficulty with understanding or manipulating numerical quantities and performing arithmetic that is not explained by inadequate instruction alone. It may occur as a developmental learning disorder or result from acquired brain injury, particularly involving dominant parietal networks.

## Dyscrasia

An historic term broadly referring to any abnormal condition of the blood or bone marrow, now used primarily in the context of plasma cell dyscrasias (also called monoclonal gammopathies).

### Synonyms:

monoclonal gammopathies).

## Dysentery

Severe diarrheal illness with blood and mucus in stool, typically caused by *Shigella*, *Salmonella*, *Campylobacter*, or *Entamoeba histolytica*. Presents with frequent bloody stools, abdominal cramps, tenesmus, and fever. Diagnosis: stool culture, microscopy, PCR.

## Dysesthesia

An unpleasant, abnormal sensation produced by a normally non-painful stimulus, or an unpleasant, exaggerated response to a normal stimulus. It is distinguished from paresthesia (which is simply an abnormal sensation that may or may not be unpleasant) by its consistently unpleasant quality.

## Dysgeusia

Distortion, reduction, or loss of the normal sense of taste. It may result from oral or nasal disease, viral infection, neurological injury, nutritional deficiency, systemic illness, or medication exposure and may occur with altered smell, dry mouth, or mucosal inflammation.

## Dysgraphia

A learning disorder involving persistent difficulty with handwriting, spelling, written expression, or the motor and language skills required for writing. spelling, written composition, or the motor and language processes required for writing. It may occur alone or with other learning, language, attention, or neurological disorders.

## Dyslexia

A specific learning disorder with neurobiological origin, characterized by difficulties with accurate and fluent word recognition, spelling, and decoding ability, despite adequate intelligence, motivation, and educational opportunity. Affects approximately 5–10% of the population.

### Synonyms:

Reading Disability, Specific Reading Disability

## Dyslipidemia

An abnormal concentration or composition of circu-

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lating lipoproteins, including elevated low-density lipoprotein cholesterol, elevated triglycerides, reduced high-density lipoprotein cholesterol, or mixed abnormalities.

### **Dysmenorrhea**

Painful menstruation, often causing cramping pelvic pain. See Menstrual Cramps.

### **Dactylomegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of a finger or toe, which may occur as an isolated finding or as part of an endocrine, skeletal, vascular, or inflammatory disorder.

### **Dracunculosis**

Infection caused by the parasitic nematode *Dracunculus medinensis*, acquired by drinking water containing infected copepods. It classically produces a painful blister and emergence of a long adult worm through the skin.

### **Diapedesis**

Movement of blood cells, especially leukocytes, through intact vessel walls into surrounding tissue.

### **Dorsal Blocking Splint**

A hand splint that holds the wrist and fingers in a protective position, often used after flexor-tendon repair to limit extension and protect healing tendons.

### **Dysmenorrhoea**

Painful menstruation, classified as primary (no identifiable pelvic pathology) or secondary (underlying structural or inflammatory condition).

### **Dyspareunia**

Painful sexual intercourse.

### **Dyspepsia**

Chronic or recurrent pain or discomfort centered in the upper abdomen. Organic causes: peptic ulcer disease, GERD, gastritis, gastric cancer. Functional dyspepsia is diagnosed after exclusion of organic

pathology with normal upper endoscopy. Rome IV criteria define subtypes: epigastric pain syndrome and postprandial distress syndrome.

### **Dysphagia**

Difficulty swallowing, classified as oropharyngeal (difficulty initiating a swallow, choking, coughing, nasal regurgitation) or esophageal (sensation of food sticking retrosternally).

#### **Synonyms:**

Difficulty Swallowing Trouble Swallowing

### **Dysphagia (Geriatric)**

Difficulty swallowing, common in elderly. Causes: neurological (stroke, Parkinson's), structural (cancer, stricture), muscular (presbyesophagus), medications. Symptoms: coughing with eating, choking, pocketing food, weight loss, aspiration. Assessment: clinical exam, videofluoroscopy, endoscopy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Dysphagia Diet**

A texture- and consistency-modified diet prescribed after assessment of swallowing safety. Liquids and foods may be thickened or altered to reduce aspiration risk while maintaining adequate energy, protein, hydration, and patient acceptability.

### **Dysphagia Rehabilitation**

Therapy to improve safe swallowing and nutrition in a person with dysphagia. It may include swallow exercises, compensatory techniques, diet modification, and education based on the cause and swallowing assessment.

### **Dysphasia**

A language disorder caused by damage to the language-dominant hemisphere of the brain (typically left), involving difficulty with expression, comprehension, reading, or writing. Dysphasia (often used interchangeably with aphasia): partial loss of language function.



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## Dysphonia

An abnormal voice quality encompassing hoarseness, breathiness, roughness, vocal fatigue, pitch breaks, and strained or whispered speech. It is organic when due to structural laryngeal pathology (nodules, polyps, laryngitis, laryngeal cancer) and functional when due to voice misuse, muscle tension dysphonia, or psychogenic causes.

## Dysplasia

Disordered cellular growth and maturation characterized by structural abnormalities within a tissue, representing a pre-neoplastic condition that may progress to invasive carcinoma. The changes may include variation in cell size and shape, nuclear atypia, abnormal maturation, and architectural disorganization. Clinical significance depends on the organ, grade, persistence of the causative stimulus, and evidence of invasion.

## Desmoplasia

Formation of dense fibrous connective tissue in response to invasive neoplasia, chronic inflammation, or tissue injury. The reaction is produced by activated stromal cells and extracellular-matrix deposition surrounding or infiltrating a lesion. Desmoplasia is especially common around invasive carcinomas and may make a tumor firm, tethered, or difficult to distinguish from scar tissue. Its presence is interpreted with the cellular morphology, location, and clinical findings to determine whether it represents a tumor-associated stromal response.

## Dysplastic Nevus

Atypical nevus: a melanocytic lesion with clinical and histologic atypia, larger (>5-6 mm), with irregular borders, variable color (pink-tan-brown), and a macular/papular component; often multiple in the dysplastic nevus syndrome (familial atypical mole-melanoma, FAMMM).

## Dyspnea

The subjective sensation of difficult or uncomfortable breathing. See Shortness of Breath. It may result from cardiopulmonary, metabolic, neuromuscular, or psychological causes.

## Dyspnea On Exertion

Shortness of breath precipitated by physical activity, a cardinal symptom of cardiac and pulmonary disease. Cardiac causes: heart failure, coronary artery disease (angina equivalent), valvular disease; pulmonary: COPD, asthma, ILD, anemia, deconditioning. Quantified by NYHA functional class (heart failure) and mMRC scale (dyspnea).

## Dyspnoea

The subjective sensation of difficult or labored breathing. See Shortness of Breath.

## Dysthymia (Persistent Depressive Disorder)

A chronic form of depression with depressed mood for most of the day, more days than not, for  $\geq 2$  years ( $\geq 1$  year in children/adolescents). Symptoms: poor appetite or overeating, insomnia or hypersomnia, low energy, low self-esteem, poor concentration, and hopelessness.

### Synonyms:

Persistent Depressive Disorder

## Dystonia

A movement disorder characterized by sustained or intermittent muscle contractions causing abnormal, often repetitive, movements and postures.

## Dystrophic Calcification

The deposition of calcium phosphate salts in damaged, necrotic, or degenerating tissues despite normal serum calcium levels. It occurs in areas of tissue injury, inflammation, or chronic degeneration where the local tissue environment favors calcium precipitation.

## Dysuria

Painful, burning, or uncomfortable sensation experienced during urination. Most commonly indicates inflammation or infection of the lower urinary tract. Causes in females: acute cystitis, urethritis (Chlamydia trachomatis, Neisseria gonorrhoeae), vaginitis (Candida, Trichomonas), and vulvar atrophy.



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### **Dacryocystocele**

A cystic swelling caused by blockage and dilation of the tear-duct system, usually near the inner corner of the eye.

### **Demyelination**

Loss or damage of the myelin sheath that normally insulates nerve fibers and speeds nerve signaling.

### **Dental Calculus**

Hardened dental plaque formed when mineral salts accumulate on teeth.

### **Denys-Drash Syndrome**

A rare genetic disorder associated with abnormal kidney development, nephropathy, and an increased risk of Wilms tumor.

### **Dermatographic Urticaria**

A form of hives in which scratching or pressure causes raised, itchy lines on the skin.

### **Deuteranopia**

Red-green color blindness caused by absence or severe dysfunction of green-sensitive cone photopigments.

### **Diabetic Angiopathy**

Blood-vessel damage caused by diabetes, affecting small or large vessels.

### **Diastolic Murmur**

A heart murmur heard while the heart relaxes between contractions.

### **Distal Pancreatectomy**

Surgical removal of the body or tail of the pancreas, usually with preservation of the pancreatic head.

### **DNA Damage**

A chemical or structural change in DNA that can interfere with gene function or replication.

### **Duane Retraction Syndrome**

A congenital eye-movement disorder in which abnormal eye-muscle innervation limits horizontal movement and may cause the eye to retract.

### **Duodenal Obstruction**

Partial or complete blockage that prevents contents from passing through the duodenum.

### **Dysfibrinogenemia**

An inherited or acquired disorder in which fibrinogen is abnormal and blood clotting may be impaired or excessive.

### **D2 Receptor**

A dopamine receptor involved in movement, motivation, reward, and some psychiatric disorders.

### **De Quervain's Tendonitis**

Painful inflammation or narrowing of the tendons on the thumb side of the wrist.

### **Declarative Memory**

Memory for facts and events that can be consciously recalled.

### **Decongestant**

A medicine that reduces swelling of the nasal lining and relieves nasal congestion.

### **Deep Sleep**

The deepest stage of non-rapid-eye-movement sleep, during which arousal is difficult and physical restoration occurs.

### **Delayed Sleep Phase Syndrome**

A circadian-rhythm disorder in which sleep and waking occur substantially later than desired.

### **Dementia Pugilistica**

A progressive brain disorder associated with repeated head trauma, historically described in some professional boxers.

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### **Demineralization**

Loss of mineral from a tissue, such as tooth enamel or bone, which may weaken the tissue.

### **Dermal Papilla**

A structure at the base of a hair follicle that supplies signals and nutrients important for hair growth.

### **Detrusor Instability**

Involuntary bladder-muscle contractions that can cause urgency and urge incontinence.

### **Detrusor Muscle**

The smooth muscle in the bladder wall that contracts to expel urine.

### **Detumescence**

The return of an erectile tissue to its non-erect state.

### **Diastolic Blood Pressure**

The pressure in the arteries while the heart relaxes between contractions.

### **Diastolic Heart Failure**

Heart failure in which impaired ventricular relaxation or increased stiffness limits filling of the heart.

### **Dietary Fiber**

Plant material that is not fully digested and supports bowel function and other aspects of health.

### **Digital Rectal Examination**

Examination of the rectum and nearby structures using a lubricated, gloved finger.

### **Digitalis**

A group of cardiac glycosides, including digoxin, that can increase cardiac contraction and affect heart rhythm.

### **Dihydrotestosterone**

A potent androgen formed from testosterone that contributes to prostate growth and male sexual development.

### **Direct Transmission**

Spread of an infectious organism through immediate contact or short-range respiratory droplets from an infected source.

### **Discoid Lupus Erythematosus**

A chronic form of cutaneous lupus that causes persistent, inflamed skin plaques that may scar.

### **Diverticulum**

A pouch-like projection from the wall of a hollow organ, especially the intestine.

### **Dorsal Kyphosis**

Excessive forward curvature of the upper spine, often associated with vertebral fractures or degenerative change.

### **Double-Blind Study**

A clinical study in which neither participants nor the investigators assessing outcomes know the assigned treatment group.

### **Dry-Powder Inhaler**

A device that delivers powdered medicine to the lungs when the user inhales through it.

### **Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry**

An imaging test that measures bone mineral density, commonly abbreviated DEXA or DXA.

### **Dupuytren's Disease**

Thickening and shortening of tissue in the palm that progressively bends one or more fingers toward the palm.

### **Delayed Sleep Phase**

A circadian-rhythm disorder in which a person falls asleep and wakes later than desired; also called delayed sleep-wake phase disorder.

#### **Synonyms:**

delayed sleep-wake phase disorder. Delayed Sleep-Wake Phase Sleep Disorder DSPS DSWPD

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### **Dermatographia**

A form of physical urticaria in which scratching or pressure causes raised, red, itchy lines on the skin.

### **Desmoplastic Small Round Cell Tumors**

Rare aggressive tumors that usually arise in the abdomen or pelvis and primarily affect children and young adults.

#### **Synonyms:**

DSRCT

### **Diabetic Coma**

A state of profound unconsciousness caused by a severe diabetes-related disturbance in blood glucose or metabolism.

### **Diabetic Hypoglycemia**

An abnormally low blood glucose level in a person with diabetes, often caused by insulin or other glucose-lowering medicines.

### **Diffuse Large B-Cell Lymphoma**

A fast-growing cancer of B lymphocytes and the most common type of non-Hodgkin lymphoma.

### **Diffuse Midline Glioma**

An aggressive brain or spinal-cord tumor arising in midline structures, often in children.

### **Dislocated Shoulder**

Displacement of the upper arm bone from the shoulder joint.

### **Double Uterus**

A congenital condition in which the uterus develops as two separate cavities or two uteruses.

### **Double-Outlet Right Ventricle**

A congenital heart defect in which both major arteries arise mainly from the right ventricle.

### **Dry Macular Degeneration**

The more common form of age-related macular degeneration, involving gradual damage to the macula without abnormal blood-vessel growth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dry Age-Related Macular Degeneration Dry AMD Macular Degeneration, Dry

### **Dry Eyes**

Irritation or discomfort caused by inadequate tear production or excessive tear evaporation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Decreased Tear Production Keratoconjunctivitis Sicca (Dry Eyes) Tears, Decreased Production

### **Dry Mouth**

A condition in which the mouth does not produce enough saliva; also called xerostomia.

#### **Synonyms:**

xerostomia.

### **Dural Arteriovenous Fistulas**

Abnormal connections between arteries and veins in the dura mater surrounding the brain or spinal cord.

### **Dyshidrosis**

A skin disorder causing small, intensely itchy blisters on the palms, sides of the fingers, or soles.

#### **Synonyms:**

Eczema, Dyshidrotic

### **Ductal Carcinoma In Situ**

A noninvasive breast cancer in which abnormal cells remain within the milk ducts; commonly abbreviated DCIS.

### **Dermabrasion**

A procedure that mechanically removes superficial layers of skin to improve selected scars, wrinkles, pigment changes, or lesions.

### **Dermatology**

The medical specialty concerned with the diagnosis and treatment of diseases of the skin, hair, nails, and mucous membranes.

### **Dermatome**

A surgical instrument used to remove a thin layer

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of skin for grafting. The term also describes a band of skin supplied by one spinal nerve.

### **Dermatoplasty**

Surgical repair or reconstruction of the skin, often using tissue rearrangement or a skin graft.

### **Desensitization**

A treatment that gradually reduces an abnormal immune response by giving increasing or controlled exposure to a specific allergen.

### **Diaphoresis**

Excessive sweating, which may occur with heat, exertion, fever, pain, low blood sugar, or other medical conditions.

### **Diarthrosis**

A freely movable joint, usually a synovial joint, in which the bones are separated by a joint cavity.

### **Diencephalon**

The part of the brain between the cerebrum and brainstem that includes the thalamus and hypothalamus.

### **Digestive System**

The organs that digest food, absorb nutrients and water, and eliminate solid waste, including the gastrointestinal tract and accessory organs.

### **Digit**

A finger or toe.

### **Dilation And Evacuation**

A procedure in which the cervix is dilated and pregnancy tissue is removed from the uterus using suction and surgical instruments.

### **Diopter**

A unit of optical power equal to the reciprocal of the focal length in meters.

### **Doppler Echocardiography**

Echocardiographic imaging that uses Doppler ultra-

sound to assess the direction and speed of blood flow through the heart and great vessels.

### **Duodenal Bulb**

The first, expanded portion of the duodenum immediately beyond the pylorus.

### **Duodenal Papilla**

A mucosal projection in the duodenum where the bile duct and pancreatic duct, usually through the major papilla, empty into the intestine.

### **Dukes Classification**

An older staging system for colorectal cancer based mainly on how far the tumor has extended through the bowel wall and into lymph nodes or distant sites.

### **Dynamometer**

An instrument used to measure force, commonly hand-grip strength or muscle strength.

### **Dysmetria**

Inability to control the range, force, or speed of a voluntary movement, commonly caused by cerebellar dysfunction.

### **Dacryolithiasis**

Formation of a stone or concretion within the lacrimal drainage system, which may cause excessive tearing, discharge, recurrent dacryocystitis, or obstruction.

### **Dakin Solution**

A dilute sodium hypochlorite solution used as a topical antiseptic for selected contaminated or infected wounds. Concentration and exposure time must be controlled because stronger solutions can injure viable tissue.

### **Danon Disease**

A rare X-linked lysosomal storage disorder caused by LAMP2 mutations, characterized by cardiomyopathy, skeletal-muscle weakness, and variable intellectual or retinal involvement.

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## Decannulation

Removal of a cannula or tube, especially a tracheostomy tube, after the patient can maintain a safe airway and adequate breathing, secretion clearance, and oxygenation.

## Deep Brain Stimulation

A treatment in which implanted electrodes deliver controlled electrical impulses to selected brain regions. It is used for conditions such as Parkinson disease, essential tremor, and some forms of dystonia.

## Deiodinase

An enzyme that removes iodine atoms from thyroid hormones, thereby activating or inactivating thyroxine and triiodothyronine and regulating local thyroid-hormone action.

## Dejerine-Roussy Syndrome

Central post-stroke pain caused by a lesion of the thalamus or related sensory pathways. It may produce persistent contralateral pain, burning, abnormal sensation, or pain from normally nonpainful stimuli.

## De Lange Syndrome

A congenital developmental disorder, also called Cornelia de Lange syndrome, involving characteristic facial features, growth and developmental delay, limb abnormalities of variable severity, and intellectual disability.

### Synonyms:

Cornelia de Lange syndrome, involving characteristic facial features, growth and developmental delay, limb abnormalities of variable severity, and intellectual disability.

## Dry Socket

Painful inflammation of a tooth socket caused by loss or failure of the blood clot after tooth extraction. Also called alveolar osteitis.

### Synonyms:

alveolar osteitis.

## Death Rattle

Noisy, rattling breathing caused by secretions accumulating in the throat or upper airways, often occurring near the end of life when swallowing and coughing weaken.

## Decalcification

Loss of calcium salts from bone, teeth, or other mineralized tissue. In teeth it may weaken enamel; in bone it can contribute to reduced strength.

## Deglutition (Swallowing)

The coordinated process of moving food, liquid, or saliva from the mouth through the pharynx and esophagus into the stomach.

### Synonyms:

Swallowing

## Dehiscence

Separation or reopening of the edges of a wound or surgical closure. Wound dehiscence may be superficial or involve deeper tissues and requires clinical assessment.

## Diathesis

A predisposition or susceptibility to developing a particular disease, symptom, or physiological response, such as a bleeding diathesis.

## Diplegia

Paralysis or marked weakness affecting corresponding parts on both sides of the body, classically the legs more than the arms in spastic diplegia.

## Disarticulation

Amputation performed through a joint rather than by cutting through the shaft of a bone.

## Dressing

Material applied to a wound to protect it, absorb exudate, maintain a suitable healing environment, or deliver local treatment.

## Drip (Intravenous Infusion)

Controlled administration of fluid, blood, nutrients,

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or other substances directly into a vein through a cannula or catheter.

**Synonyms:**

Intravenous Infusion

**Dyskinesia**

Abnormal, often involuntary movement that may be excessive, repetitive, irregular, or purposeless. Causes include neurological disease and medication effects.

**Dyspraxia (Developmental Coordination Disorder)**

Difficulty planning and coordinating voluntary movements that interferes with daily activities, learning, or motor skills and is not explained by a primary muscle or sensory disorder.

**Synonyms:**

Developmental Coordination Disorder

**Dysreflexia (Autonomic Dysreflexia)**

A potentially life-threatening episode of uncontrolled autonomic activity, usually in people with spinal-cord injury above T6, triggered by stimuli such as bladder or bowel distension.

**Synonyms:**

Autonomic Dysreflexia

**Dystocia**

Difficult or abnormal labor caused by problems with uterine contractions, the fetus, or the maternal pelvis and soft tissues.

**Dystrophy**

Abnormal development, growth, maintenance, or degeneration of a tissue or organ, often reflecting an inherited or metabolic disorder. The term is used in conditions such as muscular dystrophy, corneal dystrophy, retinal dystrophy, and nail dystrophy. Clinical effects depend on the affected tissue and may include progressive weakness, visual impairment, structural fragility, or loss of function. Diagnosis generally combines clinical examination with laboratory, imaging, electrophysiologic, genetic, or histopathologic studies as appropriate.

**Dating Ultrasound**

An ultrasound examination, usually performed in early pregnancy, used to estimate gestational age and calculate the expected date of delivery. First-trimester crown-rump length is generally the most accurate ultrasound measurement for dating.

**Synonyms:**

Pregnancy dating scan; gestational-age ultrasound.

**Daidzein**

A naturally occurring isoflavone found in soy and other legumes that can be converted by intestinal bacteria into related compounds.

**Debility**

A state of weakness or loss of strength, often associated with illness, aging, or prolonged inactivity.

**Synonyms:**

Weakness

**Decoction**

A preparation made by simmering plant material in water to extract soluble substances.

**Defenses**

The body's protective mechanisms against infection, injury, and other threats, including physical barriers and immune responses.

**Synonyms:**

Body defenses

**Degenerative Disease**

A disorder in which the structure or function of tissues progressively deteriorates.

**Synonyms:**

Degenerative disorder

**Degenerative Disk Disease**

Age-related or injury-related deterioration of an intervertebral disk that may cause back or neck pain.

**Synonyms:**

Degenerative disc disease



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### Degenerative Joint Disease

Progressive loss of cartilage and changes in a joint, commonly referring to osteoarthritis.

**Synonyms:**

Osteoarthritis

### Degenerative Spondylolisthesis

Forward displacement of one vertebra over another caused by degenerative changes in the spine.

### Delta Waves

Large, slow brain waves associated with deep non-REM sleep.

**Synonyms:**

Delta rhythm

### Demulcent

A substance that soothes irritated or inflamed mucous membranes by forming a protective coating.

### Dendrites

Branching extensions of nerve cells that receive signals from other neurons or sensory receptors.

### Dendritic Cells

Immune cells that capture foreign material and present antigens to T cells, helping initiate an adaptive immune response.

### Deoxyribonucleic Acid

The molecule that stores hereditary genetic information in cells.

**Synonyms:**

DNA

### Desiccated Thyroid

A thyroid-hormone preparation made from dried animal thyroid tissue and containing thyroid hormones.

**Synonyms:**

Desiccated thyroid extract; natural desiccated thyroid

### Dietary Supplements

Products such as vitamins, minerals, herbs, or other substances taken to supplement the diet.

**Synonyms:**

Nutritional supplements

### Digestive Tract

The continuous hollow passage from the mouth through the throat, esophagus, stomach, intestines, and anus.

**Synonyms:**

Gastrointestinal tract; alimentary canal

### Dilate

To become wider or cause a passage, vessel, or opening to become wider.

**Synonyms:**

Expand; enlarge

### Disk

A flat, round structure; in the spine, an intervertebral disk separates adjacent vertebrae and cushions movement.

**Synonyms:**

Disc

### Dithiolethione

A sulfur-containing compound studied for its ability to activate cellular protective and detoxification pathways.

### D-Limonene

A citrus-derived compound found in the oils of orange, lemon, and other citrus fruits.

**Synonyms:**

Limonene

### DNR

An abbreviation for do-not-resuscitate, indicating that cardiopulmonary resuscitation should not be attempted if breathing or heartbeat stops.

**Synonyms:**

Do-not-resuscitate

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### **Do-Not-Resuscitate Order**

A medical order instructing clinicians not to perform CPR if a person's breathing or heartbeat stops.

**Synonyms:**

DNR order

### **Dopamine**

A neurotransmitter involved in movement, motivation, reward, attention, and regulation of several hormonal functions.

### **Double Blind**

A study design in which neither participants nor the researchers assessing outcomes know who receives each intervention during the blinded phase.

**Synonyms:**

Double-masked

### **Double-Contrast Barium Enema**

An imaging examination of the colon using barium and air to outline the bowel wall on X-rays.

**Synonyms:**

Air-contrast barium enema

### **Dowager's Hump**

An exaggerated upper-back curvature, usually caused by vertebral compression fractures or osteoporosis.

**Synonyms:**

Kyphosis

### **Doxazosin**

An alpha-1 blocker used to relax smooth muscle and treat high blood pressure or urinary symptoms from an enlarged prostate.

### **Dressler's Syndrome**

Inflammation of the pericardium that develops weeks after heart-muscle injury, such as a heart attack or cardiac surgery.

**Synonyms:**

Post-myocardial-infarction syndrome

### **DRI**

A set of nutrient reference values used to plan and

assess dietary intake for healthy people.

**Synonyms:**

Dietary Reference Intakes

### **Dry Eye**

A condition in which the eyes do not produce enough tears or tears evaporate too quickly, causing irritation and visual discomfort.

**Synonyms:**

Dry-eye disease; keratoconjunctivitis sicca

### **Dual Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry**

A low-dose imaging test that measures bone mineral density and can help assess fracture risk.

**Synonyms:**

DXA; DEXA

### **Dual-Photon Absorptiometry**

An older bone-density measurement technique that uses two photon energies to estimate bone mineral content.

### **Duct**

A tube or channel that carries a fluid, such as bile, pancreatic juice, or secretions from a gland.

### **Duplex Doppler Ultrasound Scanning**

An ultrasound test that combines structural imaging with Doppler measurement of blood flow through vessels.

**Synonyms:**

Duplex ultrasound

### **Dacarbazine**

An alkylating chemotherapy medicine used for Hodgkin lymphoma, melanoma, and selected other cancers; important toxicities include severe nausea, bone-marrow suppression, and liver injury.

### **Dacetuzumab**

A medicine called dacetuzumab. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

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### **Daclizumab**

A medicine called daclizumab. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dacomitinib**

A medicine called dacomitinib. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dacryocyte Analysis**

Dacryocyte analysis is used in relation to dacryocyte analysis during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Dactinomycin**

A medicine called dactinomycin. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dalotuzumab**

A medicine called dalotuzumab. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dalteparin**

A low-molecular-weight heparin that enhances antithrombin activity against factor Xa and is used to prevent or treat venous thromboembolism; bleeding and dose adjustment in severe kidney disease are important considerations.

### **Dalteparin Sodium**

The sodium salt of dalteparin, a low-molecular-weight heparin used to prevent or treat venous thromboembolism; bleeding is the principal serious adverse effect.

### **Danazol**

A synthetic androgen with antigonadotropic effects, used selectively for endometriosis, hereditary angioedema, or other conditions; androgenic, lipid, liver, and thrombotic adverse effects limit use.

### **Dantrolene**

A skeletal-muscle relaxant that reduces calcium release from the sarcoplasmic reticulum; it is the specific treatment for malignant hyperthermia and may cause weakness or liver injury.

### **Danuserib**

An investigational aurora-kinase inhibitor studied as an anticancer drug; it is not an established routine treatment.

### **Dapsone**

A sulfone antimicrobial used for leprosy, selected dermatitis, and other infections; haemolysis, especially with G6PD deficiency, methaemoglobinaemia, agranulocytosis, and severe skin reactions are important risks.

### **Daptomycin**

A medicine called daptomycin. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Darbepoetin Alfa**

A clinical condition or finding involving darbepoetin alfa. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Darunavir**

A medicine called darunavir. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dasatinib**

A medicine called dasatinib. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Daunorubicin**

A clinical condition or finding involving daunorubicin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Daunorubicin Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving daunoru-

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bicin hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dav Regimen**

The term is ambiguous without its source context; it may refer to a named treatment regimen, so the full regimen and indication must be specified before clinical use.

### **Dcc Gene**

A gene encoding the netrin-1 receptor DCC, which guides developing axons and may act as a tumor suppressor; pathogenic variants can cause developmental or cancer-related phenotypes.

### **Dcmp Deaminase**

An abbreviation or enzyme name requiring source confirmation; the full molecular name and clinical context should be verified before interpretation.

### **De Novo**

Newly arising in an individual rather than inherited from either parent; the term is commonly used for genetic variants or disease presentations.

### **Debrisoquin**

An antihypertensive drug formerly used to reduce sympathetic nerve activity; it is now mainly relevant as a probe of CYP2D6 drug metabolism.

### **Decanoic Acid**

A ten-carbon saturated fatty acid, also called capric acid, found in some fats and studied for antimicrobial, metabolic, and antiseizure effects.

### **Decenoic Acid**

An unsaturated ten-carbon fatty acid; its biologic effects depend on the position and geometry of its double bond and on tissue and dietary context.

### **Decerebrate State**

Decerebrate state is used in relation to decerebrate state during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Deciduoma**

Deciduoma is an old term for a decidual reaction or mass-like overgrowth of pregnancy-related uterine lining, not a true tumor.

### **Deciduous Tooth**

A primary or baby tooth that is eventually shed and replaced by a permanent tooth.

### **Decision Making**

The process of comparing information, options, benefits, risks, and preferences to choose an action or plan, including shared decision-making in health-care.

### **Decitabine**

A cytidine-analog antineoplastic agent that inhibits DNA methyltransferase and is used for selected myelodysplastic syndromes and acute myeloid leukemia.

### **Declopramide**

Not a standard generic drug name in common medical use; it may be a misspelling of metoclopramide and should be verified against the original source.

### **Decorin**

A small proteoglycan of the extracellular matrix that binds collagen and influences tissue structure, growth-factor signaling, and fibrosis.

### **Decreased Concentration**

Reduced ability to sustain attention or mental focus; causes include sleep loss, stress, medications, mood disorders, substance use, and neurologic or medical illness.

### **Decreased Dentin**

Reduced thickness or formation of dentin, the mineralized tissue beneath tooth enamel; causes include developmental defects, wear, erosion, caries, or dental treatment.

### **Decreased Libido**

Reduced sexual desire that may be related to re-

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relationships, mood, stress, medications, hormones, chronic illness, pain, or other health factors.

### **Defective Virus**

Defective virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Defense Mechanism**

A psychological process, often unconscious, that helps a person manage conflict, anxiety, or distress; its usefulness depends on context and flexibility.

### **Defensin**

An antimicrobial peptide produced by epithelial cells and immune cells that disrupts microbial membranes and contributes to innate immunity.

### **Deferasirox**

An oral iron-chelating medicine used to reduce chronic iron overload when clinically indicated; kidney, liver, hearing, and gastrointestinal toxicity require monitoring.

### **Deferiprone**

An oral iron chelator used for transfusional iron overload; neutropenia or agranulocytosis is an important adverse effect requiring blood-count monitoring.

### **Deferoxamine**

A parenteral iron chelator used for severe or chronic iron overload and sometimes aluminum toxicity; treatment requires monitoring for ocular, auditory, renal, and infectious complications.

### **Defined Observation**

An observation recorded using a specified definition, measurement method, time point, or assessment rule so that it can be interpreted consistently.

### **Deformity**

A deformity is an abnormal shape, alignment, or structure of a body part caused by development, injury, disease, or growth.

### **Degarelix**

A clinical condition or finding involving degarelix. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Degenerative Disorder**

A disease in which progressive cellular or tissue deterioration causes loss of structure or function, as in neurodegenerative, joint, retinal, or muscle disorders.

### **Deglutition**

Deglutition is swallowing, the coordinated movement of food or liquid from the mouth through the pharynx and esophagus into the stomach.

### **Degranulation**

Release of stored granule contents from cells such as mast cells, basophils, neutrophils, and cytotoxic lymphocytes during immune or inflammatory responses.

### **Degrees Fahrenheit**

A temperature measurement expressed on the Fahrenheit scale; 32 degrees Fahrenheit is the freezing point of water and 212 degrees is its boiling point at standard pressure.

### **Dehydroascorbic Acid**

The oxidized form of vitamin C that can be transported into cells and reduced back to ascorbate, contributing to redox and antioxidant chemistry.

### **Dehydroepiandrosterone**

An adrenal steroid precursor that can be converted to androgens and estrogens; levels vary with age, adrenal disorders, medicines, and supplements.

### **Deinstitutionalize**

To move a person from long-term institutional care toward community-based living and support, when safe and appropriate.

### **Deja Vu**

A feeling that a current situation has been experi-

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enced before, despite recognizing that it is probably new; frequent or distressing episodes may warrant evaluation.

### **Delavirdine**

A non-nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor formerly used in combination antiretroviral therapy for HIV; interactions and resistance limit its use.

### **Delayed Orgasm**

Persistent difficulty reaching orgasm despite adequate sexual stimulation, potentially related to medications, health conditions, psychological factors, or relationship context.

### **Deletion Mutation**

A genetic variant in which one or more DNA bases are absent; its effect depends on the location, size, and whether it alters a gene or regulatory region.

### **Delftia**

A genus of aerobic Gram-negative bacteria found in soil and water; human infection is uncommon but has been reported, especially in people with significant underlying illness.

### **Delftia Acidovorans**

An environmental gram-negative bacterium that rarely causes bloodstream or other opportunistic infection, particularly in people with devices or impaired immunity.

### **Delphi Technique**

A structured research method that uses repeated anonymous surveys and feedback to develop expert consensus.

### **Deltacoronavirus**

Deltacoronavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Deltaretrovirus**

Deltaretrovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Delta-Tocopherol**

One naturally occurring form of vitamin E; its biological and antioxidant effects differ from those of alpha-tocopherol, the principal form used to assess human vitamin E status.

### **Deltoid**

The deltoid is the large shoulder muscle that lifts the arm and helps stabilize the shoulder joint.

### **Demeclocycline**

A medicine called demeclocycline. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Demecolcine**

A colchicine-related antimitotic compound that disrupts microtubules; it has limited medical use and can be toxic.

### **Demethylation**

Demethylation is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Demographics Domain**

The demographic characteristics of a population or study group, such as age, sex, ethnicity, location, education, or socioeconomic measures.

### **Denaturant**

Denaturant is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dendrimer**

Dendrimer is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process



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involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Dendritic Spine**

A small protrusion on a neuronal dendrite that receives many excitatory synaptic inputs and can change with learning and disease.

### **Denervation**

Denervation is loss of nerve supply to a muscle or tissue, causing weakness, atrophy, altered sensation, or autonomic dysfunction.

### **Denileukin Difitox**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving denileukin difitox; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Denominator**

The number below the line in a fraction; in a rate or proportion it identifies the population or total against which the numerator is compared.

### **Denosumab**

A medicine called denosumab. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Densitometry**

A clinical condition or finding involving densitometry. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Density**

Density is used in relation to density during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Dent Disease**

An inherited X-linked proximal renal-tubule disorder causing low-molecular-weight proteinuria, hypercalciuria, kidney stones or nephrocalcinosis, and progressive kidney impairment.

### **Dental Alloy**

Dental alloy refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Alveolus**

Dental alveolus refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Amalgam**

Dental amalgam refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Anxiety**

Dental anxiety refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Arch**

Dental arch refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Articulator**

Dental articulator refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Cement**

Dental cement refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Clasp**

Dental clasp refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Deposit**

Dental deposit refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

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### **Dental Dysplasia**

Dental dysplasia refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Fissure**

Dental fissure refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Hygiene**

Dental hygiene refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Impression Material**

Dental impression material refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Inlay**

Dental inlay refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Material**

Dental material refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Occlusion**

Dental occlusion refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Overjet**

Dental overjet refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Papilla**

Dental papilla refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Pellicle**

Dental pellicle refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Porcelain**

Dental porcelain refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to dental procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Dental Prosthesis**

Dental prosthesis refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Pulp**

Dental pulp refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dental Sac**

Dental sac refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dentate Gyrus**

Dentate gyrus refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dentifrice**

Dentifrice refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

### **Dentigerous Cyst**

Dentigerous cyst refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

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## Dentin Sensitivity

Dentin sensitivity refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

## Dentinogenesis

The formation of dentin by odontoblasts during tooth development and repair; inherited defects can cause abnormal tooth color, weakness, and rapid wear.

## Dentist

Dentist refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

## Dentistry

Dentistry refers to a dental structure, material, procedure, or oral-health finding involving the teeth or supporting tissues.

## Denture Base

The part of a denture that rests on the oral tissues and supports the artificial teeth.

## Denturist

A dental professional authorized in some jurisdictions to provide, fit, and maintain removable dentures within the local scope of practice.

## Deoxycoformycin

A medicine called deoxycoformycin. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## Deoxycytidine

Deoxycytidine is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxycytidine Kinase

Deoxycytidine kinase is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance

depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyglucose

Deoxyglucose is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyguanosine

Deoxyguanosine is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyribonuclease

Deoxyribonuclease is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyribonucleosides

Deoxyribonucleosides is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyribonucleotides

Deoxyribonucleotides is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Deoxyuridine

Deoxyuridine is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Dependovirus

Dependovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

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## Depersonalization

Depersonalization is a feeling of detachment or unreality regarding one's own body, thoughts, or self, often occurring with anxiety, trauma, or dissociation.

## Dephosphorylation

Dephosphorylation is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Depressive Disorder

A mood disorder with persistent depressed mood or loss of interest plus cognitive, physical, and functional symptoms; severity, duration, and suicide risk guide care.

## Depth Perception

Depth perception is the ability to judge distance and three-dimensional relationships using binocular vision, motion, perspective, and other cues.

## Depurination

Loss of a purine base from DNA, leaving an abasic site that can contribute to mutation if not repaired.

## Derealization

Derealization is a feeling that the external world is unreal, dreamlike, distant, or visually altered, often associated with anxiety, trauma, dissociation, or substances.

## Dermabacter

Dermabacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Dermabacter Hominis

Dermabacter hominis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and an-

timicrobial susceptibility.

## Dermatan Sulfate

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan found in connective tissue and involved in extracellular-matrix structure and coagulation-related biology.

## Dermatologic Disorder

A disease affecting skin, hair, nails, or cutaneous glands, producing findings such as rash, scale, pigment change, ulcers, pain, or itching.

## Dermatologist

A physician specializing in diagnosis and treatment of disorders of the skin, hair, nails, and related mucous membranes.

## Dermatomycosis

A fungal infection of the skin, hair, or nails.

## Desflurane

Desflurane is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Desipramine

Desipramine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Deslorelin

Deslorelin is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Desmin

Desmin is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

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## Desmoid Tumors

A neoplastic process affecting desmoid tumors; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Desmoplastic

Desmoplastic is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Desmoplastic Fibroma

A rare benign but locally aggressive fibrous tumor of bone.

## Desmopressin

Desmopressin is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Desmosine

Desmosine is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Desmosome

Desmosome is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Desogestrel

Desogestrel is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Desonide

Desonide is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Desoximetasone

A topical corticosteroid used to reduce inflammation and itching in steroid-responsive dermatitis; potency, site, duration, and skin absorption determine risk.

## Desoxycorticosterone

A mineralocorticoid steroid that promotes renal sodium retention and potassium loss, influencing extracellular fluid volume and blood pressure.

## Desulfovibrio

A genus of anaerobic sulfate-reducing bacteria found in the environment and gut; invasive infection is uncommon and usually requires compatible clinical findings.

## Desulfovibrio Desulfuricans

A sulfate-reducing anaerobic bacterium found mainly in environmental and gastrointestinal habitats; human disease is rare.

## Desulfovibrio Piger

A sulfate-reducing anaerobic bacterium associated with the human intestinal microbiota; its clinical significance depends on the specimen and patient context.

## Desulfovibrionaceae

A family of anaerobic sulfate-reducing bacteria that includes *Desulfovibrio* species.

## Desvenlafaxine Succinate

Desvenlafaxine succinate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Detached

Detached means separated or no longer connected, as in a detached retina, tissue, device, or emotional state.

## Detergent

Detergent is a chemical, environmental, or toxicol-

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ogy term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Deubiquitinating Enzymes**

Enzymes that remove ubiquitin from proteins, thereby regulating protein stability, trafficking, signaling, DNA repair, and immune responses.

### **Deubiquitination**

Deubiquitination is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Deuterium**

Deuterium is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Deuterium Oxide**

Water in which some or all hydrogen atoms are the heavy isotope deuterium; it is also called heavy water and is used in research.

### **Developmental Disabilities**

A group of lifelong conditions beginning during development that affect physical, intellectual, language, learning, or adaptive functioning.

### **Developmental Process**

The biological and psychological changes through which an organism, organ, or ability grows, differentiates, and acquires function.

### **Developmental Psychology**

The study of cognitive, emotional, social, and behavioral change across the lifespan.

### **Developmental Stage**

A period of characteristic physical, cognitive, emotional, or social development used to describe progression over time.

### **Device Embolisation**

Migration of a medical device or device fragment

through the bloodstream, potentially obstructing a vessel and requiring urgent assessment.

### **Dexamethasone**

A potent, long-acting glucocorticoid used to suppress inflammation, cerebral oedema, allergic reactions, and selected malignancy-related or endocrine conditions; infection, hyperglycaemia, and adrenal suppression may occur.

### **Dexlansoprazole**

A medicine called dexlansoprazole. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dexmedetomidine**

Dexmedetomidine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dexmethylphenidate**

Dexmethylphenidate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dexrazoxane**

Dexrazoxane is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dexrazoxane Hydrochloride**

Dexrazoxane hydrochloride is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dextroamphetamine**

Dextroamphetamine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.



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### **Dextromethorphan**

Dextromethorphan is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dextrothyroxine**

Dextrothyroxine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Diabetic Cardiomyopathies**

Structural or functional heart-muscle disease associated with diabetes, after considering other causes such as coronary artery disease and hypertension.

### **Diacetoxyscirpenol**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving diacetoxyscirpenol; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Diacylglycerol**

Diacylglycerol is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Diagnostic Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to diagnostic procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Diagnostic Service**

A healthcare service that obtains or interprets information to detect, characterize, or monitor a disease or health condition.

### **Diagnostic Trial**

A clinical study evaluating how well a test identifies or excludes a disease or predicts a clinically relevant outcome.

### **Diakinesis**

Diakinesis is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Dialister Microaerophilus**

A microaerophilic anaerobic bacterium associated with the oral and genital microbiota; clinical significance depends on isolation from a compatible infection.

### **Dialister Pneumosintes**

An anaerobic bacterium found in the oral cavity and respiratory tract that may contribute to polymicrobial infection in appropriate clinical settings.

### **Dialysis Solutions**

Specially formulated fluids used in hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis to exchange solutes and remove excess water from the body.

### **Dialysis Therapy**

Dialysis therapy is used in relation to dialysis therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Diamine**

A molecule containing two amino groups; diamines occur in metabolism and are used in biochemical and industrial chemistry.

### **Dianhydrogalactitol**

Dianhydrogalactitol is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Dianisidine**

Dianisidine is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

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## Diapause

Diapause is a period of suspended or slowed development in some animals, allowing survival during unfavorable environmental conditions.

## Diaphoretic

Causing or relating to sweating.

## Diaphragmatic Eventration

Abnormal thinning and elevation of part or all of the diaphragm due to muscle weakness or defective development.

## Diastematomyelia

Diastematomyelia is a congenital spinal-cord malformation in which the cord is split into two portions, often with vertebral or skin abnormalities.

## Diastolic Murmurs

Heart sounds heard during diastole, often caused by abnormal blood flow through a valve or great vessel and requiring clinical evaluation.

## Diatomaceous Earth

Diatomaceous earth is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Diatrizoate Meglumine

Diatrizoate meglumine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Diazepam

A benzodiazepine that enhances GABA-A receptor activity and is used for anxiety, muscle spasm, seizures, and alcohol withdrawal; sedation, respiratory depression, dependence, and withdrawal are important risks.

## Diazinon

Diazinon is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, inter-

actions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Diaziquone

Diaziquone is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Diazonium Compounds

A clinical condition or finding involving diazonium compounds. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Diazooxonorleucine

Diazooxonorleucine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Diazoxide

Diazoxide is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Dibekacin

Dibekacin is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Dibucaine

A medicine called dibucaine. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## Dicarboxylic Acid

An organic molecule containing two carboxyl groups; dicarboxylic acids participate in metabolism and can accumulate in selected inherited or acquired metabolic disorders.

## Dichlorophen

Dichlorophen is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term.

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cology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dichlorvos**

Dichlorvos is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dickeya Dadantii**

A plant-pathogenic bacterium that causes soft rot and wilt in plants; it is not a usual human pathogen.

### **Diclofenac**

A clinical condition or finding involving diclofenac. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diclofenac Sodium**

A clinical condition or finding involving diclofenac sodium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dicloxacillin**

A medicine called dicloxacillin. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dicrotophos**

Dicrotophos is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dictyostelium**

A genus of social amoebae used in cell and developmental biology research; it is not a usual human pathogen.

### **Dicyclomine**

Dicyclomine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Didanosine**

Didanosine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical

formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dientamoeba**

Dientamoeba is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Dientamoeba Fragilis**

Dientamoeba fragilis is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Diestrus**

The phase of the reproductive cycle in many mammals between estrus periods, characterized by activity of the corpus luteum or its regression.

### **Diet**

A diet is the pattern of foods and beverages a person consumes, shaped by nutritional needs, culture, health, access, and preference.

### **Diet Therapy**

Diet therapy is used in relation to diet therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Dietary Calcium**

Dietary calcium is a healthcare or clinical-care term; its appropriate use depends on the patient's condition, goals, risks, available evidence, and professional assessment.

### **Dietary Carbohydrate**

Dietary carbohydrate is used in relation to dietary carbohydrate during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Dietary Fats**

Dietary fats provide energy and essential fatty acids and help absorb fat-soluble vitamins; health effects

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depend on type, amount, and overall diet.

### **Dietary Iron**

Dietary iron supports hemoglobin, myoglobin, and enzymes and is obtained as heme iron from animal foods or nonheme iron from plants and fortified foods.

### **Dietary Phospholipid**

A food-derived amphipathic lipid containing phosphate, used in cell membranes and lipoproteins and metabolized according to diet, absorption, and liver function.

### **Dietary Phosphorus**

A biological substance or process involving dietary Phosphorus; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Dietary Protein**

Protein consumed in food and digested into amino acids and peptides needed for tissue maintenance, enzymes, hormones, immunity, and energy when required.

### **Dietary Steroid**

A dietary steroid is a steroid compound consumed in food or supplements; sterols and hormones can affect metabolism or interact with medicines.

### **Dietary Sterol**

A dietary sterol is a cholesterol-like molecule in food, including plant sterols that can reduce intestinal cholesterol absorption.

### **Dietary Supplement**

A dietary supplement is a product intended to add nutrients or other substances to the diet; contents, evidence, quality, and interactions vary.

### **Dietary Supplementation**

Dietary supplementation is deliberate addition of nutrients or other substances to food intake to address deficiency, support a goal, or alter health.

### **Dietetics**

Dietetics is the applied science and professional practice of using nutrition and diet to promote health and manage disease.

### **Diethylhexylphthalate**

Diethylhexyl phthalate is a plasticizer used in some products; exposure can affect endocrine and reproductive systems and is regulated in many settings.

### **Diethylnitrosamine**

Diethylnitrosamine is a chemical carcinogen used in research models and capable of causing liver and other organ injury.

### **Diethylpropion**

Diethylpropion is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Diethylstilbestrol**

Diethylstilbestrol is a synthetic estrogen formerly given during pregnancy; prenatal exposure is associated with reproductive-tract abnormalities and certain cancers.

### **Dietitian**

A dietitian is a nutrition professional who assesses dietary needs and provides individualized nutrition counseling within the scope of local licensing.

### **Differentiation Antigens**

Differentiation antigens is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Difficulty Walking**

Impaired gait or mobility that may result from pain, weakness, balance problems, sensory loss, joint disease, neurologic illness, or cardiopulmonary limitation.

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## **Diffuse**

Diffuse means spread broadly or throughout an area rather than confined to a small, well-defined focus.

## **Diffuse Astrocytoma**

Diffuse astrocytoma is an infiltrating tumor of astrocytic glial cells; modern classification uses molecular features and many formerly defined low-grade types have been reclassified.

## **Diffuse Scleroderma**

Diffuse scleroderma is a systemic-sclerosis pattern with widespread skin thickening and possible internal-organ fibrosis affecting the lungs, kidneys, heart, or gastrointestinal tract.

## **Diffusion Anisotropy**

Direction-dependent movement of water molecules in tissue, especially along white-matter fibers; it is measured with diffusion MRI.

## **Diffunisal**

Diffunisal is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## **Digastric Muscle**

Digastric muscle refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## **Digestive Disorder**

A disease affecting the gastrointestinal tract or digestion, causing symptoms such as pain, nausea, reflux, diarrhea, constipation, bleeding, or malabsorption.

## **Digital Mammography**

A clinical condition or finding involving digital mammography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Digitalis Preparation**

A preparation containing cardiac glycosides such

as digoxin or digitoxin that can increase cardiac contractility and slow atrioventricular conduction; toxicity can cause arrhythmias and visual or gastrointestinal symptoms.

## **Digitonin**

A steroidal saponin used mainly in laboratory work to permeabilize cell membranes by binding membrane cholesterol.

## **Digitoxin**

A clinical condition or finding involving digitoxin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Digoxin**

A clinical condition or finding involving digoxin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Dihydroxyacetone**

A three-carbon sugar used in metabolism; its derivative dihydroxyacetone phosphate is an intermediate in glycolysis and gluconeogenesis.

## **Dilatation**

Dilatation is widening or expansion of a hollow organ, vessel, duct, or other structure.

## **Dilation**

Dilation is widening or expansion of a hollow organ, vessel, duct, pupil, or other structure, whether normal, induced, or disease-related.

## **Diltiazem**

A clinical condition or finding involving diltiazem. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Dimenhydrinate**

An antihistamine used to prevent or treat motion sickness and nausea; drowsiness and anticholinergic effects are common concerns.

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### **Dimesna**

Dimesna is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dimethoate**

Dimethoate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dimethoxon**

Dimethoxon is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dimethyl Fumarate**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimethyl fumarate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dimethyl Sulfoxide**

Dimethyl sulfoxide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in dimethyl sulfoxide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Dimethylbenzanthracene**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimethylbenzanthracene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dimethylhydrazines**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimethylhydrazines. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dimethylnitrosamine**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimethylnitrosamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dimetilan**

Dimetilan is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dinaciclib**

Dinaciclib is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dinitrochlorobenzene**

Dinitrochlorobenzene is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dinitrofluorobenzene**

Dinitrofluorobenzene is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dinophyceae**

The class containing dinoflagellates, aquatic microorganisms that can produce toxins or harmful algal blooms affecting human health.

### **Dinoprost**

A clinical condition or finding involving dinoprost. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dinoprostone**

Dinoprostone is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dinucleoside Phosphates**

Dinucleoside phosphates is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.



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### **Dinutuximab**

A medicine called dinutuximab. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dioxin**

Dioxin is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dipeptide**

Dipeptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in dipeptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Dipetalonema**

A genus of filarial nematodes; some species infect animals and rarely humans, with significance depending on species and exposure.

### **Dipetalonema Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving dipetalonema infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Diphenoxylate**

Diphenoxylate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Diphenylhydramine**

Diphenylhydramine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Diphosphate**

Diphosphate is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Diphosphonate**

Diphosphonate is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Diphtheria Toxin**

Diphtheria toxin is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

### **Diphyllbothriasis**

Intestinal infection caused by fish tapeworms, especially Diphyllbothrium or related Dibothriocephalus species; it may cause abdominal symptoms or vitamin B12 deficiency.

### **Diploid Cell**

A cell containing two complete sets of chromosomes, one inherited from each parent; most human somatic cells are diploid.

### **Diploidy**

Diploidy is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Dipstick Device**

A clinical condition or finding involving dipstick device. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diptera**

The insect order containing flies and mosquitoes; some members transmit infections or cause myiasis.

### **Diphtheroid Bacillus**

Diphtheroid bacillus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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### **Dipylidium Caninum**

A dog and cat tapeworm that can occasionally infect people, especially children, after swallowing an infected flea.

### **Dipyridamole**

Dipyridamole is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dirty Necrosis**

Tumor necrosis containing abundant nuclear debris and neutrophils, classically seen in some high-grade carcinomas such as colorectal adenocarcinoma.

### **Disaccharide**

Disaccharide is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

### **Disclosure**

A clinical condition or finding involving disclosure. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Discriminant Analysis**

Discriminant analysis is used in relation to discriminant analysis during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Discrimination Learning**

A clinical condition or finding involving discrimination learning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Disease Progression**

The change and usually worsening of a disease over time, assessed through symptoms, examination, biomarkers, imaging, function, complications, or treatment response.

### **Disease Reservoir**

A person, animal, environmental site, or material in which an infectious agent normally lives and from which it can spread to a susceptible host.

### **Disease Response**

The biologic or clinical reaction to a disease or its treatment, measured by symptoms, signs, laboratory results, imaging, function, or survival.

### **Disease Susceptibility**

Increased likelihood of developing a disease because of genetic traits, immune status, age, exposures, behavior, comorbidities, or other risk factors.

### **Disease Vector**

A living carrier, commonly a mosquito, tick, flea, or other arthropod, that transmits an infectious agent between hosts without necessarily becoming ill.

### **Disfigurement**

Disfigurement is a visible change that substantially alters appearance, caused by injury, disease, surgery, congenital difference, or scarring.

### **Disinfectant**

A clinical condition or finding involving disinfectant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Disopyramide**

A class IA antiarrhythmic drug used selectively for certain rhythm disorders; anticholinergic effects, negative inotropy, and proarrhythmia limit its use.

### **Dispensed Amount**

The quantity of a medicine supplied to a patient, determined by the prescription, dose, duration, formulation, and applicable dispensing rules.

### **Disruption**

Disruption is interruption or breakdown of normal structure, function, continuity, or process.

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## Disseminate

To disseminate means to spread widely, as an infection, cancer, inflammation, or information.

## Disseminated Neuroblastoma

A neoplastic process affecting disseminated neuroblastoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Distamycins

A medicine called distamycins. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## Distant

Distant means far from a reference point or primary site; in cancer, distant disease indicates spread to remote organs or lymph nodes.

## Distended

Distended means abnormally stretched, swollen, or enlarged by fluid, gas, blood, tissue, or pressure.

## Distress

Distress is significant physical or emotional suffering, discomfort, or strain that may accompany illness, injury, treatment, or difficult circumstances.

## Disulfiram

A medicine used as an adjunct for alcohol-use disorder that inhibits aldehyde dehydrogenase and can cause an unpleasant reaction if alcohol is consumed.

## Disulfoton

Disulfoton is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Diterpenes

A class of compounds built from four isoprene units; they occur in plants, fungi, and some animal products and have diverse biological effects.

## Ditiocarb

A chemical term for dithiocarbamate compounds, which can act as chelators or pesticides and may have toxic effects depending on the agent and exposure.

## Diutina Rugosa

A yeast species that is an uncommon opportunistic human pathogen, mainly reported in people with underlying illness or immunosuppression.

## Divorce

Divorce is legal dissolution of a marriage and can affect health through stress, finances, housing, caregiving, social support, and access to care.

## Dizygotic Twin

One of a pair of fraternal twins formed when two ova are fertilized by two sperm; the twins share about half their segregating genes on average.

## DNA Adduct

A chemical group covalently attached to DNA after exposure to a reactive compound; unrepaired adducts can distort replication and create mutations or cancer risk.

## DNA Alkylation

Addition of an alkyl group to DNA bases or the phosphate backbone, which can alter base pairing, block replication, and cause mutations or cell death.

## DNA Binding

A clinical condition or finding involving dna binding. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## DNA Demethylation

Removal or loss of methyl groups from DNA, changing chromatin accessibility and gene expression during development, reprogramming, or disease.

## DNA Fingerprinting

Analysis of variable DNA regions to distinguish individuals or establish biological relationships, used

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in forensic identification, paternity testing, and some research applications.

### **DNA Footprinting**

A molecular method that identifies the DNA sequence protected by a bound protein because that region is less susceptible to enzymatic or chemical cleavage.

### **DNA Fragmentation**

Breaking of DNA strands into smaller pieces, occurring during apoptosis, injury, radiation, or laboratory analysis; excessive or abnormal fragmentation can impair genome integrity.

### **DNA Gyrase**

A clinical condition or finding involving dna gyrase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DNA Integration**

Insertion of foreign or copied DNA into a host genome, occurring in evolution, gene therapy, or viral infection and potentially altering nearby gene activity.

### **DNA Ligases**

A clinical condition or finding involving dna ligases. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DNA Ligation**

Joining of DNA fragments by forming a phosphodiester bond, catalyzed by DNA ligase during replication, repair, recombination, and molecular cloning.

### **DNA Methylation**

Addition of methyl groups to DNA, usually at cytosine bases, that can alter chromatin and gene expression without changing the DNA sequence.

### **DNA Packaging**

A clinical condition or finding involving dna packaging. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DNA Primase**

A clinical condition or finding involving dna primase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DNA Primers**

A clinical condition or finding involving dna primers. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DNA Probe**

A labeled single-stranded nucleic-acid sequence that binds a complementary target and allows a specific gene, organism, mutation, or chromosome region to be detected.

### **DNA Virus**

DNA virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Dobutamine**

An intravenous beta-1-adrenergic agonist that increases cardiac contractility and is used short term for selected cases of acute low-output heart failure or shock.

### **Docetaxel**

A medicine or chemical compound called docetaxel. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Doconexent**

A pharmaceutical name for docosahexaenoic acid, an omega-3 fatty acid found in fish oils and cellular membranes.

### **Docosadienoic Acid**

A 22-carbon fatty acid with two double bonds, present in some lipids and studied for effects on membranes and metabolism.

### **Docosahexaenoic Acid**

The omega-3 fatty acid DHA, a major structural

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lipid in brain and retina obtained from marine foods or synthesized from precursors.

### **Docosapentaenoic Acid**

A 22-carbon polyunsaturated fatty acid with five double bonds, occurring as omega-3 or omega-6 forms in tissues and diet.

### **Docosatrienoic Acid**

A 22-carbon fatty acid containing three double bonds, present in small amounts in lipids and involved in experimental studies of metabolism.

### **Dodecenoic Acid**

An unsaturated 12-carbon fatty acid whose biologic properties depend on the position and configuration of its double bond.

### **Dolasetron**

A medicine or chemical compound called dolasetron. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Dolasetron Mesylate**

Dolasetron mesylate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Dolichol**

A long-chain lipid alcohol involved in assembling sugar chains for protein glycosylation in the endoplasmic reticulum.

### **Dolosigranulum Pigrum**

A Gram-positive bacterium commonly found in the upper respiratory tract; it is usually a commensal, though rare infections have been reported.

### **Domperidone**

Domperidone is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

### **Donepezil**

A clinical condition or finding involving donepezil. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Donohue Syndrome**

A severe inherited insulin-resistance disorder caused by pathogenic INSR variants, characterized by poor growth, loss of body fat, abnormal facial features, and early metabolic complications.

### **Dopa**

A precursor of dopamine; levodopa crosses the blood–brain barrier and is used with an aromatic L-amino-acid decarboxylase inhibitor to treat Parkinson disease.

### **Dopamine Antagonist**

A clinical condition or finding involving dopamine antagonist. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dopamine Receptor**

Dopamine receptor is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in dopamine receptor and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Dopamine Transporter**

A clinical condition or finding involving dopamine transporter. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dopaminergic Neuron**

A clinical condition or finding involving dopaminergic neuron. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dorea**

A genus of anaerobic bacteria commonly found in the human intestine; detection generally reflects microbiota unless recovered from a compatible sterile-site infection.

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## **Doripenem**

A clinical condition or finding involving doripenem. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Dorsal Funiculus**

The dorsal funiculus is the posterior white-matter column of the spinal cord carrying vibration, fine touch, and position signals upward to the brain.

## **Dorsolateral**

Dorsolateral means located toward the back and side of a body structure or region.

## **Dosage Forms**

A clinical condition or finding involving dosage forms. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Dose Rate**

Dose rate is used in relation to dose rate during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Double-Blind Method**

A clinical condition or finding involving double-blind method. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Doxapram**

Doxapram is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## **Doxazosin Mesylate**

Doxazosin mesylate is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## **Doxepin**

Doxepin is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific

agent and clinical use.

## **Doxercalciferol**

Doxercalciferol is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## **Doxorubicin**

A clinical condition or finding involving doxorubicin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Doxorubicin Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving doxorubicin hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Doxycycline**

A medicine called doxycycline. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## **Doxycycline Hyclate**

A medicine called doxycycline hyclate. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## **Doxylamine**

Doxylamine is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## **Dracunculiasis**

Guinea-worm disease, a parasitic infection caused by *Dracunculus medinensis* and acquired by drinking water containing infected copepods.

## **Dracunculus Medinensis**

The Guinea-worm parasite that causes dracunculiasis after ingestion of infected copepods in unsafe drinking water.



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## Drainage

Removal of fluid, pus, blood, or air from a body site or wound, either naturally or using a procedure or drain.

## Dream

A dream is a sequence of perceptions, thoughts, or emotions during sleep, often most vivid during REM sleep.

## Dried Specimen

A clinical condition or finding involving dried specimen. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Drinking Water

Water intended for human consumption; it should meet local safety standards and be treated when contamination with pathogens or chemicals is possible.

## Dronabinol

A synthetic form of delta-9-tetrahydrocannabinol used for selected cases of chemotherapy-related nausea or appetite loss; central nervous-system effects and interactions are important.

## Drool

Excess saliva escaping from the mouth, which may result from increased production, impaired swallowing, poor oral closure, or neurologic disease.

## Droperidol

A butyrophenone dopamine antagonist used in selected settings for nausea or agitation; QT prolongation and arrhythmia risk require appropriate precautions.

## Dropper Bottle

A container fitted with a dropper for delivering a liquid in drops; the prescribed product, concentration, and number of drops must be followed carefully.

## Drosophila Proteins

Proteins produced by fruit flies and used as experi-

mental models of development, signaling, genetics, immunity, and human disease mechanisms.

## Drosophilidae

The family of insects commonly called fruit flies or vinegar flies; they are important in genetics research and are not typical human parasites.

## Drug Abuse

A nonpreferred term for harmful or nonmedical use of a drug; current clinical language generally uses substance use, misuse, or substance use disorder according to the situation.

## Drug Administration Route

The pathway by which a medicine enters the body, such as oral, intravenous, intramuscular, inhaled, topical, or subcutaneous administration.

## Drug Emulsion

A pharmaceutical preparation in which one liquid is dispersed as droplets within another immiscible liquid, often stabilized with an emulsifier.

## Drug Eruption

A skin eruption caused by a medication, ranging from a mild morbilliform rash to severe reactions such as Stevens–Johnson syndrome or toxic epidermal necrolysis.

## Drug Implant

A solid or device-based dosage form placed in tissue to release a medicine locally or systemically over an extended period.

## Drug Implants

Implantable dosage forms or devices that release a medicine over time; selection and monitoring depend on the product and clinical indication.

## Drug Metabolism

The enzymatic conversion of medicines into metabolites, mainly in the liver but also in the intestine, kidneys, lungs, and other tissues.

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## Drug Packaging

The container, labeling, and protective materials used to preserve a medicine and support correct identification, storage, and use.

## Drug Vehicle

An inactive substance or carrier used to deliver an active drug ingredient in a formulation.

## Dry Cough

A cough that produces little or no sputum; causes include viral illness, asthma, reflux, medications such as ACE inhibitors, and other airway or lung disease.

## Dry Ice

Dry ice is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Dubowitz Syndrome

A rare developmental disorder associated with growth restriction, characteristic facial features, microcephaly, intellectual or behavioral differences, and variable immune or skin findings.

## Dull Pain

Dull pain is used in relation to dull pain during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Duloxetine Hydrochloride

A clinical condition or finding involving duloxetine hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dumbbell Ossification

Bone formation or a bony lesion with a dumbbell shape, often describing extension through a neural foramen or across adjacent anatomical compartments.

## Duocarmycins

A medicine called duocarmycins. Its uses, dosing,

adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

## Duodenal Adenocarcinoma

A neoplastic process affecting duodenal adenocarcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Duodenal Disease

A disorder of the first part of the small intestine, including inflammation, ulceration, obstruction, infection, bleeding, malabsorption, or neoplasia.

## Duodenal Fistula

A clinical condition or finding involving duodenal fistula. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Duodenal Hemorrhage

Duodenal hemorrhage refers to duodenal hemorrhage, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Duodenal Infection

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving duodenal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

## Duodenal Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting duodenal neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Duodenal Stenosis

Duodenal stenosis refers to duodenal stenosis, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Duodenoscope

A flexible endoscope designed to examine the duodenum and access the bile and pancreatic ducts, commonly during ERCP.

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## Duodenostomy

A surgically created opening from the duodenum to the skin or another bowel segment, usually for drainage or feeding in selected circumstances.

## Durapatite

Hydroxyapatite, the calcium-phosphate mineral that gives bone and teeth much of their hardness.

## Dust

Dust is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Dutasteride

A clinical condition or finding involving dutasteride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dye

A clinical condition or finding involving dye. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dye Lasers

A clinical condition or finding involving dye lasers. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dynamin Gtpase

Dynamin gtpase is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Dynein Atpase

Dynein atpase is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the tissue and context.

## Dynorphin

Dynorphin is a biochemical, genetic, or cellular term describing a molecule, reaction, structure, or process involved in biology; its significance depends on the

tissue and context.

## Dyphylline

Dyphylline is a medicine, drug candidate, or pharmaceutical formulation; its indication, dose, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and clinical use.

## Dysbarism

Illness caused by changes in ambient pressure, including decompression sickness and barotrauma during diving, flying, or hyperbaric exposure.

## Dysgammaglobulinemia

Dysgammaglobulinemia concerns dysgammaglobulinemia, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Dysgerminoma

Dysgerminoma is a malignant germ-cell tumor of the ovary, analogous to seminoma of the testis, and often occurs in adolescents or young adults.

## Dyskeratosis Congenita

Dyskeratosis congenita is an inherited telomere-biology disorder causing abnormal nails, skin pigmentation, oral leukoplakia, marrow failure, and cancer risk.

## Dyslipidemias

Abnormal blood-lipid concentrations, such as high LDL cholesterol, high triglycerides, or low HDL cholesterol, that can increase atherosclerotic and pancreatitis risk.

## Dysostoses

Inherited or developmental disorders in which one or more bones form abnormally.

## Dyssomnias

Sleep disorders involving difficulty initiating or maintaining sleep, excessive sleepiness, or abnormal regulation of the sleep–wake cycle.

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## Dystonia Disorder

A movement disorder causing sustained or intermittent involuntary muscle contractions that produce twisting movements, repetitive actions, or abnormal postures.

## Dystonin

A clinical condition or finding involving dystonin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dystrophia Unguium

Abnormal nail growth or structure, which may result from trauma, infection, inflammatory disease, nutritional deficiency, medication, or an inherited disorder.

## Dystrophin

A clinical condition or finding involving dystrophin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dangerous Abbreviations

Abbreviations that can be misread and cause medication or clinical errors; safer practice is to write the complete term when an abbreviation is ambiguous.

## Ductal Carcinoma In Situ (DCIS)

A noninvasive breast cancer in which abnormal cells are confined to the milk ducts and have not spread into surrounding breast tissue.

### Synonyms:

DCIS Intraductal Carcinoma

## Deep Vein Thrombosis (DVT)

A blood clot in a deep vein, usually in the leg, that can cause swelling and pain and may travel to the lungs as a pulmonary embolism.

## Dermatographia (Dermatographism)

A condition in which light scratching or pressure causes temporary raised red lines or welts on the skin.

### Synonyms:

Skin Writing

## Diabetic Nephropathy (Kidney Disease)

Kidney damage caused by diabetes, often beginning with protein in the urine and potentially progressing to chronic kidney disease.

## Diffuse Midline Glioma (DMG)

An aggressive central nervous system tumor arising in midline brain structures, most often affecting children.

### Synonyms:

DMG

## DiGeorge Syndrome (22Q11.2 Deletion Syndrome)

A genetic disorder caused by deletion of part of chromosome 22, potentially affecting the heart, immune system, calcium regulation, palate, and development.

### Synonyms:

Velocardiofacial Syndrome

## Dissociative Disorders

Mental health disorders involving disruption in the normal integration of identity, memory, consciousness, emotion, perception, or behavior.

## DCIS

Alternate index label; see *Ductal carcinoma in situ (DCIS)*.

## DDH

Alternate index label; see *Hip dysplasia*.

## Decreased Tear Production

Alternate index label; see *Dry eyes*.

## Deficient Color Vision

Alternate index label; see *Color blindness*.

## Degenerative Arthritis

Alternate index label; see *Osteoarthritis*.

## Delayed Gastric Emptying

Alternate index label; see *Gastroparesis*.

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**Delayed Sleep-Wake Phase Sleep Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *Delayed sleep phase*.

**Dementia, Frontotemporal**

Alternate index label; see *Frontotemporal dementia*.

**Dementia, Lewy Body**

Alternate index label; see *Lewy body dementia*.

**Dementia, Vascular**

Alternate index label; see *Vascular dementia*.

**Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever**

Alternate index label; see *Dengue fever*.

**Dependence, Nicotine**

Alternate index label; see *Nicotine dependence*.

**Depression, Postpartum**

Alternate index label; see *Postpartum depression*.

**Depression, Teen**

Alternate index label; see *Teen depression*.

**Dermatitis, Atopic**

Alternate index label; see *Atopic dermatitis (eczema)*.

**Dermatitis, Cercarial**

Alternate index label; see *Swimmer's itch*.

**Dermatitis, Contact**

Alternate index label; see *Contact dermatitis*.

**Dermatitis, Scratch**

Alternate index label; see *Neurodermatitis*.

**Dermatitis, Seborrheic**

Alternate index label; see *Seborrheic dermatitis*.

**Devic's Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Neuromyelitis optica*.

**DFSP**

Alternate index label; see *Dermatofibrosarcoma protuberans*.

**Diabetes, Gestational**

Alternate index label; see *Gestational diabetes*.

**Diabetes, Type 1**

Alternate index label; see *Type 1 diabetes*.

**Diabetes, Type 1 In Children**

Alternate index label; see *Type 1 diabetes in children*.

**Diabetes, Type 2**

Alternate index label; see *Type 2 diabetes*.

**Diabetes, Type 2 In Children**

Alternate index label; see *Type 2 diabetes in children*.

**Diarrhea, Antibiotic-Associated**

Alternate index label; see *Antibiotic-associated diarrhea*.

**Diarrhea, Traveler's**

Alternate index label; see *Traveler's diarrhea*.

**Difficulty Speaking**

Alternate index label; see *Voice disorders*.

**Difficulty Swallowing**

Alternate index label; see *Dysphagia*.

**DMG**

Alternate index label; see *Diffuse midline glioma (DMG)*.

**Dissecting Aneurysm**

Alternate index label; see *Aortic dissection*.

**Drop Foot**

Alternate index label; see *Foot drop*.

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### **Dry Age-Related Macular Degeneration**

Alternate index label; see *Dry macular degeneration*.

### **Dry AMD**

Alternate index label; see *Dry macular degeneration*.

### **DSPS**

Alternate index label; see *Delayed sleep phase*.

### **DSRCT**

Alternate index label; see *Desmoplastic small round cell tumors*.

### **DSWPD**

Alternate index label; see *Delayed sleep phase*.

### **Dunbar Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Median arcuate ligament syndrome (MALS)*.

### **Dysrhythmias**

Alternate index label; see *Heart arrhythmia*.

### **Dystonia, Cervical**

Alternate index label; see *Cervical dystonia*.

### **D-Dimer Test**

D-dimer testing measures a fibrin-degradation product; an elevated result can support evaluation for thrombosis but is nonspecific and must be interpreted with pretest probability.

### **D-Xylose Absorption**

A test of intestinal absorption that measures the handling of orally administered D-xylose.

### **Daily Bowel Care Program**

A planned routine for preventing and treating constipation or fecal incontinence, often including timing, fluids, diet, activity, medication, and rectal measures when prescribed.

### **DASH Diet To Lower High Blood**

### **Pressure**

A patient-care topic concerning dash diet to lower high blood pressure. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Deciding About An IUD**

A clinical condition or finding involving deciding about an iud. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deciding About Hormone Therapy**

A shared clinical decision that weighs symptoms, goals, benefits, contraindications, risks, alternatives, and the person's medical history before hormone therapy.

### **Deciding About Treatments That Prolong Life**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to deciding about treatments that prolong life; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Deciding To Have Knee Or Hip Replacement**

A decision based on pain, functional limitation, imaging, nonoperative treatment response, surgical risk, expectations, and shared discussion with an orthopedic clinician.

### **Deciding To Quit Drinking Alcohol**

A clinical condition or finding involving deciding to quit drinking alcohol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Decreased Alertness**

Decreased alertness is reduced awareness or responsiveness that may result from metabolic illness, intoxication, infection, seizure, stroke, trauma, or sleep-related causes.

### **Deep Breathing After Surgery**

Breathing exercises used after surgery to improve



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lung expansion and reduce atelectasis; technique and need depend on the operation and patient condition.

### **Deep Vein Thrombosis - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning deep vein thrombosis - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Defining Overweight And Obesity In Children**

Classification of excess body mass in children using age- and sex-specific body-mass-index percentiles, growth patterns, health effects, and clinical context rather than adult cutoffs.

### **Delayed Growth**

Slower-than-expected increase in height, weight, or head size compared with standardized growth patterns, caused by nutrition, chronic disease, endocrine disorders, genetics, or normal variation.

### **Delayed Puberty In Boys**

Failure of testicular enlargement and other pubertal changes to begin by the expected age in a boy, caused by constitutional delay, chronic illness, hypogonadism, or hypothalamic-pituitary disease.

### **Delayed Puberty In Girls**

Absence or inadequate progression of breast development or menstruation beyond expected age, caused by constitutional delay, low energy availability, chronic illness, ovarian failure, or hypothalamic-pituitary disease.

### **Delivery Presentations**

The part of the fetus that is positioned to enter the birth canal first, such as vertex, breech, or shoulder presentation; presentation affects obstetric planning.

### **Delta-ALA Urine Test**

A urine test measuring delta-aminolevulinic acid, used in evaluation of porphyria and selected toxic exposures.

### **Dementia - Behavior And Sleep Problems**

Behavioral and sleep changes that can occur in dementia, including agitation, wandering, apathy, hallucinations, or altered sleep-wake timing; causes and reversible contributors should be assessed.

### **Dementia - Daily Care**

A patient-care topic concerning dementia - daily care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dementia - Home Care**

A patient-care topic concerning dementia - home care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dementia - Keeping Safe In The Home**

Home-safety planning for a person with dementia, including supervision, fall and fire prevention, medication management, driving review, wandering precautions, and caregiver support.

### **Dementia - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical test or examination related to dementia - what to ask your doctor. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, test method, and reference range.

### **Dementia And Driving**

A clinical condition or finding involving dementia and driving. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dementia Due To Metabolic Causes**

Cognitive impairment caused or worsened by metabolic problems such as thyroid disease, vitamin deficiency, organ failure, electrolyte disturbance, or medication toxicity; some causes are treatable.

### **Dental Care - Adult**

A patient-care topic concerning dental care - adult. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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### **Dental Care - Child**

A patient-care topic concerning dental care - child. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dental Crowns**

A clinical condition or finding involving dental crowns. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dental Plaque Identification At Home**

Home inspection for the sticky bacterial biofilm on teeth, often using disclosing tablets that stain plaque and show areas missed by brushing.

### **Dental Sealants**

A clinical condition or finding involving dental sealants. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dental X-Rays**

Radiographic images of the teeth and jaws used to assess caries, bone loss, infection, trauma, and developing teeth.

### **Denture Problems**

A clinical condition or finding involving denture problems. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deodorant Poisoning**

Exposure to deodorant, which may irritate the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract; product ingredients determine severity.

### **Depilatory Poisoning**

Exposure to depilatory, which may irritate the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract; product ingredients determine severity.

### **Depression - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning depression - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Depression - Stopping Your Medicines**

Antidepressants should generally be tapered with a clinician when appropriate; abrupt stopping can cause discontinuation symptoms and relapse, while suicidal thoughts require urgent help.

### **Depression In Older Adults**

Depression in later life may include sadness, loss of interest, sleep or appetite change, slowed thinking, physical complaints, or cognitive symptoms and should be assessed for medical and medication contributors.

### **Dermal Melanocytosis**

A usually benign blue-gray patch caused by melanocytes located deeper than usual in the skin, often present at birth and commonly seen over the lower back or buttocks.

### **Dermatoses - Systemic**

Skin manifestations of a disease affecting multiple organs, such as autoimmune, endocrine, infectious, nutritional, or malignant disease; the skin finding may provide a diagnostic clue.

### **Desipramine Hydrochloride Overdose**

Overdose of desipramine hydrochloride, a tricyclic antidepressant that may cause coma, seizures, hypotension, and life-threatening cardiac conduction abnormalities.

### **Detergent Poisoning**

Exposure to detergent, which may irritate the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract; product ingredients determine severity.

### **Developmental Coordination Disorder**

A clinical condition involving developmental Coordination Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Developmental Differences Of The Female Genital Tract**

Congenital or developmental abnormalities of the female genital tract that may affect anatomy, men-

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struation, fertility, pregnancy, or urinary function.

### **Developmental Expressive Language Disorder**

A clinical condition involving developmental Expressive Language Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Developmental Milestones Record**

A record of age-related motor, language, cognitive, social, and self-care skills used to follow a child's development and identify possible delay.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 12 Months**

Expected developmental skills around one year, including pulling to stand, cruising, pointing, simple gestures, and interactive communication; individual variation exists.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 18 Months**

Expected developmental skills around 18 months, including walking, using several words, following simple directions, and beginning pretend or imitative play.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 2 Months**

Expected early-infant skills around two months, including social smiling, visual tracking, responding to sound, and improved head control.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 2 Years**

Expected skills around two years, including running, using two-word phrases, following two-step directions, and beginning parallel play.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 3 Years**

Expected skills around three years, including three-word speech, climbing stairs with support, drawing simple shapes, and cooperative social interaction.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 4 Months**

Expected skills around four months, including steady head control, rolling, reaching for objects, laughing, and responding to caregivers.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 4 Years**

Expected skills around four years, including understandable sentences, hopping, drawing a person with several parts, and imaginative cooperative play.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 5 Years**

Expected skills around five years, including running and jumping well, telling a simple story, counting, dressing with limited help, and following game rules.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 6 Months**

Expected skills around six months, including sitting with support, rolling, reaching and transferring objects, babbling, and recognizing familiar people.

### **Developmental Milestones Record - 9 Months**

Expected skills around nine months, including sitting independently, crawling or moving purposefully, babbling, responding to name, and using a pincer-like grasp.

### **Developmental Reading Disorder**

A clinical condition involving developmental Reading Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Devices For Hearing Loss**

Assistive technologies such as hearing aids, cochlear implants, bone-conduction devices, alerting systems, and communication accessories that improve access to sound.

### **Dextromethorphan Overdose**

Overdose of dextromethorphan that may cause drowsiness, agitation, hallucinations, seizures, respi-

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ratory depression, or serotonin toxicity.

### **DHEA-Sulfate Test**

A blood test measuring dehydroepiandrosterone sulfate, an adrenal androgen, to evaluate selected adrenal or androgen disorders.

### **Diabetes - Foot Ulcers**

Open sores of the foot associated with diabetes, often involving neuropathy, pressure, deformity, or poor circulation; prompt wound and infection assessment helps prevent amputation.

### **Diabetes - Insulin Therapy**

Treatment with injected or infused insulin to replace deficient insulin or improve glucose control; dosing must be individualized and balanced against hypoglycemia risk.

### **Diabetes - Keeping Active**

Regular physical activity supports glucose control and cardiovascular health in diabetes; activity should be individualized to treatment and complications.

### **Diabetes - Preventing Heart Attack And Stroke**

Cardiovascular risk reduction in diabetes includes glucose management, blood-pressure and lipid control, smoking cessation, physical activity, nutrition, and indicated medicines.

### **Diabetes - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning diabetes - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diabetes - Taking Care Of Your Feet**

A patient-care topic concerning diabetes - taking care of your feet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diabetes - When You Are Sick**

Sick-day diabetes care includes more frequent glucose checks, hydration, continuation or adjustment

of medicines as instructed, and ketone monitoring when indicated; severe symptoms need urgent care.

### **Diabetes And Alcohol**

Alcohol can cause delayed hypoglycemia, interact with medicines, and complicate glucose control; risks depend on the amount, timing, food intake, diabetes type, and treatment.

### **Diabetes And Exercise**

A clinical condition or finding involving diabetes and exercise. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diabetes And Eye Disease**

A clinical condition involving diabetes And Eye Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Diabetes And Kidney Disease**

A clinical condition involving diabetes And Kidney Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Diabetes And Nerve Damage**

Diabetic neuropathy is nerve injury associated with chronic metabolic disease and may cause pain, numbness, weakness, autonomic symptoms, or loss of protective sensation.

### **Diabetes Eye Care**

A patient-care topic concerning diabetes eye care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diabetes Eye Exams**

Eye examinations for diabetes screen for retinopathy, macular edema, cataracts, glaucoma, and other vision-threatening complications.

### **Diabetes Myths And Facts**

An educational topic distinguishing evidence-based information about diabetes from common inaccurate claims.

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## Diabetes Tests And Checkups

Diabetes testing and checkups assess glucose control and screen for complications involving the kidneys, eyes, nerves, cardiovascular system, and feet.

## Diabetes Type 2 - Meal Planning

Meal planning for type 2 diabetes emphasizes appropriate portions, fiber-rich foods, carbohydrate awareness, adequate protein, and a pattern compatible with medicines, health goals, and preferences.

## Diabetic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome

A clinical condition involving diabetic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Diagnostic Laparoscopy

A minimally invasive procedure using a camera inserted through abdominal incisions to inspect pelvic or abdominal organs and sometimes obtain biopsies or perform treatment.

## Dialysis - Hemodialysis

Blood is circulated through a dialyzer to remove waste and excess fluid when kidney function is inadequate; treatment requires vascular access and monitoring.

## Dialysis - Peritoneal

The peritoneal membrane is used as a filter by instilling and draining dialysis solution through a catheter; infection and fluid-management problems require prompt attention.

## Dialysis Centers - What To Expect

Information about dialysis-center care, including hemodialysis procedures, access care, scheduling, monitoring, and infection prevention.

## Diarrhea - What To Ask Your Doctor - Child

A patient discussion topic about childhood diarrhea, including hydration, warning signs, possible causes,

and when medical review is needed.

## Diarrhea - What To Ask Your Health Care Provider - Adult

A patient-care topic concerning diarrhea - what to ask your health care provider - adult. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Diarrhea In Infants

Frequent loose or watery stools in a baby; dehydration, blood, fever, poor feeding, lethargy, or reduced urination require prompt assessment.

## Diazepam Overdose

Overdose of diazepam, a benzodiazepine, that may cause sedation, impaired coordination, respiratory depression, or coma, especially with other depressants.

## Diazinon Poisoning

Organophosphate poisoning that can cause salivation, sweating, vomiting, diarrhea, bronchospasm, bradycardia, seizures, and respiratory failure.

## Diclofenac Sodium Overdose

Overdose of diclofenac, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug, that may cause gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, seizures, or metabolic abnormalities.

## Dieffenbachia Poisoning

Poisoning caused by calcium oxalate crystals in Dieffenbachia, producing burning and swelling of the mouth and throat after chewing.

## Diesel Oil

Toxic effects caused by excessive exposure to diesel oil. Severity depends on the dose, route, timing, and clinical findings; suspected poisoning requires prompt assessment.

## Diet - Chronic Kidney Disease

A patient-care topic concerning diet - chronic kidney disease. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks,

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management, and follow-up.

### **Diet - Liver Disease**

A patient-care topic concerning diet - liver disease. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diet After Gastric Banding**

A patient-care topic concerning diet after gastric banding. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diet And Cancer**

A patient-care topic concerning diet and cancer. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diet And Eating After Esophagectomy**

Diet after esophagectomy is advanced gradually according to swallowing function, tolerance, nutrition needs, and surgical follow-up.

### **Diet For Rapid Weight Loss**

A patient-care topic concerning diet for rapid weight loss. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diet Myths And Facts**

An educational topic distinguishing evidence-based nutrition information from common inaccurate diet claims.

### **Diet-Boosting Foods**

A patient-care topic concerning diet-boosting foods. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Diet-Busting Foods**

A patient-care topic concerning diet-busting foods. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dietary Fat And Children**

A patient-care topic concerning dietary fat and children. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

agement, and follow-up.

### **Dietary Fats Explained**

A patient-care topic concerning dietary fats explained. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dietary Guidelines For Americans 2025 - 2030**

A patient-care topic concerning dietary guidelines for americans 2025 - 2030. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Differences Of Sex Development**

Congenital variations in chromosomal, gonadal, hormonal, or internal or external genital development that do not fit typical male or female patterns.

### **Digestive Diseases**

A clinical finding or condition involving digestive Diseases; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Digital Anorectal Exam - DARE**

A physical examination using a gloved finger to assess the anal canal, rectum, and nearby structures.

### **Digital Rectal Exam**

A physical examination using a gloved finger to assess the anal canal, rectum, and nearby structures.

### **Digoxin Test**

A blood test measuring digoxin concentration to assess therapeutic exposure or suspected toxicity.

### **Dilantin Overdose**

Overdose of phenytoin, also called Dilantin, that may cause nystagmus, ataxia, slurred speech, altered consciousness, hypotension, or cardiac toxicity.

### **Dimenhydrinate Overdose**

Overdose of dimenhydrinate, an antihistamine that may cause sedation, agitation, anticholinergic effects, seizures, arrhythmias, or respiratory depression.



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sion.

### **Diphenhydramine Overdose**

Overdose of diphenhydramine, an antihistamine that may cause sedation, agitation, anticholinergic effects, seizures, arrhythmias, or respiratory depression.

### **Dirt - Swallowing**

A clinical term concerning dirt - swallowing. Its definition and clinical management depend on the context.

### **Discipline In Children**

A clinical condition or finding involving discipline in children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Disk Replacement - Lumbar Spine**

Surgery replacing a damaged lumbar intervertebral disc with an artificial disc in selected patients; benefits, risks, and suitability require specialist assessment.

### **Dislocated Shoulder - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning dislocated shoulder - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dissect**

To dissect is to separate tissue layers or structures by cutting or careful blunt separation for examination, surgery, or anatomical study.

### **Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation (DIC)**

Disseminated intravascular coagulation is uncontrolled systemic coagulation activation with consumption of platelets and clotting factors, producing simultaneous thrombosis and bleeding.

### **Disseminated Tuberculosis**

A clinical finding or condition involving disseminated Tuberculosis; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complica-

tions.

### **Distal Median Nerve Dysfunction**

Distal median nerve dysfunction causes sensory loss, pain, or weakness in the hand supplied by the median nerve and may result from compression or injury.

### **Distal Renal Tubular Acidosis**

A disorder in which the distal nephron cannot excrete acid effectively, causing non-anion-gap metabolic acidosis and sometimes low potassium, kidney stones, or bone disease.

### **Distal Splenorenal Shunt**

A clinical condition or finding involving distal splenorenal shunt. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Distracted Driving**

Driving while attention is diverted from vehicle control by a visual, manual, or cognitive task, increasing crash risk.

### **Diverticulitis - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient discussion topic about diverticulitis, including symptoms, testing, treatment, recurrence prevention, and warning signs.

### **Diverticulitis And Diverticulosis - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning diverticulitis and diverticulosis - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Dizziness And Vertigo - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning dizziness and vertigo - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Do You Have A Drinking Problem?**

A screening question about alcohol use, control, cravings, consequences, and withdrawal that can identify possible alcohol use disorder and prompt

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confidential assessment.

### **Doctor Of Medicine Profession (MD)**

The Doctor of Medicine degree is a professional qualification awarded after medical education and training; a physician's scope of practice depends on licensure and jurisdiction.

### **Doctor Of Osteopathic Medicine**

The Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine degree is a professional medical qualification that includes training in comprehensive patient care and osteopathic principles.

### **Donath-Landsteiner Test**

A laboratory test for biphasic hemolysin antibodies associated with paroxysmal cold hemoglobinuria.

### **Donovanosis (Granuloma Inguinale)**

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Klebsiella granulomatis* that produces slowly progressive, usually painless genital ulcers; diagnosis and antibiotic treatment require clinical evaluation.

### **Doppler Ultrasound Exam Of An Arm Or Leg**

An ultrasound examination that measures blood flow in the arteries and veins of an arm or leg.

### **Double Aortic Arch**

A congenital vascular ring in which two aortic arches surround the trachea and esophagus, potentially causing noisy breathing, feeding difficulty, cough, or swallowing problems.

### **Double Inlet Left Ventricle**

A rare congenital heart defect in which both atria connect predominantly to one morphologic left ventricle, producing single-ventricle circulation and mixing of oxygenated blood.

### **Doxepin Overdose**

Overdose of doxepin, a tricyclic antidepressant that may cause coma, seizures, hypotension, and life-threatening cardiac conduction abnormalities.

### **Drain Cleaner Poisoning**

Exposure to a caustic drain-cleaning product that can cause severe burns of the skin, eyes, airway, or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Drain Opener Poisoning**

Exposure to a caustic drain-cleaning product that can cause severe burns of the skin, eyes, airway, or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Drainpipe Cleaners**

A clinical term concerning drainpipe cleaners. Its definition and clinical management depend on the context.

### **Drawing Medicine Out Of A Vial**

A clinical condition or finding involving drawing medicine out of a vial. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Drinking Water Safely During Cancer Treatment**

Food and water precautions during cancer treatment aim to reduce infection risk, especially when immunity is suppressed; advice should follow the oncology team and local water guidance.

### **Driving And Older Adults**

A clinical condition or finding involving driving and older adults. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Drug Allergies**

Drug allergies are immune-mediated reactions to a medicine, ranging from rash to anaphylaxis; they must be distinguished from predictable side effects and nonimmune intolerance.

### **Drug Use First Aid**

Immediate care for suspected drug intoxication, including assessment of breathing and responsiveness, emergency activation, overdose-specific support, and naloxone when opioid toxicity is suspected.

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## Drug-Induced Diarrhea

Diarrhea caused by a medicine or drug interaction. Common causes include antibiotics, laxatives, metformin, and medicines that alter intestinal motility.

## Drug-Induced Immune Hemolytic Anemia

An uncommon immune-mediated destruction of red blood cells triggered by a medication; evaluation includes blood tests and review of exposures, with specialist management.

## Drug-Induced Low Blood Sugar

Low blood glucose caused by a medicine, most often insulin or an insulin secretagogue. Symptoms may include sweating, tremor, confusion, seizure, or loss of consciousness.

## Drug-Induced Lupus Erythematosus

A lupus-like autoimmune syndrome caused by certain medicines. Symptoms commonly include joint pain, muscle pain, and fever and usually improve after the causative medicine is stopped.

## Drug-Induced Pulmonary Disease

A pharmacologic agent associated with drug-Induced Pulmonary Disease; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

## Drug-Induced Thrombocytopenia

A low platelet count caused by a medicine through immune destruction, reduced production, or other mechanisms, increasing bleeding risk.

## Drug-Induced Tremor

Tremor caused or worsened by a medicine, stimulant, or toxin. Assessment considers timing, dose, other causes, and whether the medicine can be changed.

## Drugs That May Cause Erection Problems

Medicines that may impair erection include some antihypertensives, antidepressants, antipsychotics, antiandrogens, and other drugs; review should be

clinician-guided.

## Dry Cell Battery Poisoning

Ingestion or exposure to a dry-cell battery. Leakage or retention can cause corrosive tissue injury and requires urgent assessment.

## Dry Hair

Hair that lacks moisture or appears rough, brittle, dull, or frizzy because of weather, heat or chemical damage, infrequent conditioning, nutritional disease, or an endocrine disorder.

## Dry Mouth During Cancer Treatment

Reduced saliva during or after cancer treatment, often from head-and-neck radiation or medicines, increasing discomfort, dental caries, swallowing difficulty, and oral infection risk.

## Dry Skin - Self-Care

A patient-care topic concerning dry skin - self-care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## DTaP (Diphtheria, Tetanus, And Pertussis) Vaccine - What You Need To Know

A clinical condition or finding involving dtap (diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis) vaccine - what you need to know. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dye Remover Poisoning

Exposure to dye remover, which may irritate the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract; product ingredients determine severity.

## Dyscrasias

Dyscrasias is an older broad term for abnormal blood or body-fluid composition, often referring to hematologic disorders or abnormal blood cells.

## Damage To The Amygdala

Damage to the amygdala can affect fear processing,

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emotional learning, memory, threat recognition, and social behavior. Causes include trauma, stroke, infection, tumor, epilepsy, or degenerative disease, and effects depend on the side and extent of injury.

### **DDD (Degenerative Disc)**

Alternate index label for Degenerative Disc.

### **De Quervain's Tenosynovitis**

De Quervain tenosynovitis is painful inflammation or thickening of the thumb-side wrist tendons, often aggravated by gripping, lifting, or repetitive wrist motion. Rest, splinting, activity changes, injections, or surgery may be used according to severity.

#### **Synonyms:**

DeQuervains Tenosynovitis (De Quervain's Tenosynovitis)

### **Death Sudden Cardiac (Sudden Cardiac Death)**

Alternate index label for Sudden Cardiac Death.

### **Deficiency Primary Immunodeficiency (Primary Immunodeficiency Disease PIDD)**

Alternate index label for Primary Immunodeficiency Disease PIDD.

### **Degenerative Disc**

Degenerative disc disease describes age- or wear-related changes in spinal discs that may cause neck or back pain, stiffness, or nerve compression. Imaging changes can occur without symptoms; treatment usually begins with activity, exercise-based rehabilitation, and pain management.

#### **Synonyms:**

DDD (Degenerative Disc)

### **Dehydration: Causes And Prevention**

Dehydration occurs when fluid loss exceeds intake through vomiting, diarrhea, fever, sweating, urination, or inadequate access to fluids. Prevention includes regular intake and replacement of electrolytes when needed; confusion, fainting, minimal urine, or severe weakness requires urgent care.

### **Delayed Gastric Emptying (Gastroparesis)**

Alternate index label for Gastroparesis.

### **Dengue Fever Vs. Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever**

Dengue fever commonly causes abrupt fever, headache, muscle and joint pain, nausea, and rash. Severe dengue can cause plasma leakage, bleeding, shock, or organ injury, often around the time fever falls, and requires close monitoring and urgent treatment.

### **Dental Braces**

Dental braces apply controlled force to move teeth and align the bite over time. Treatment requires oral hygiene, dietary care, periodic adjustments, and retention afterward; risks include temporary soreness, enamel decalcification, gum problems, and root changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Braces And Retainers (Dental Braces)

### **Dental Caries (Cavities)**

Alternate index label for Cavities.

### **Dental Injuries**

Dental injuries include fractures, displacement, loosening, or loss of teeth and damage to gums or jaw after trauma. Prompt dental assessment can preserve injured teeth; uncontrolled bleeding, jaw deformity, airway problems, or head injury requires emergency care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental Trauma (Dental Injuries)

### **Dental Trauma (Dental Injuries)**

Alternate index label for Dental Injuries.

### **Depression In Children**

Depression in children may present as persistent sadness, irritability, loss of interest, withdrawal, school decline, sleep or appetite change, physical complaints, guilt, or thoughts of death. Assessment considers development, family context, medi-

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cal causes, safety, and treatment response.

**Synonyms:**

Kids Depression (Depression In Children)

**DeQuervains Tenosynovitis (De Quervain's Tenosynovitis)**

Alternate index label for De Quervain's Tenosynovitis.

**Desynchronosis (Jet Lag)**

Alternate index label for Jet Lag.

**Diabetes (Diabetes Mellitus)**

Alternate index label for Diabetes Mellitus.

**Diabetes And Eye Problems**

Diabetes can damage retinal blood vessels, causing diabetic retinopathy, macular edema, cataracts, glaucoma, and vision loss. Blood-glucose and blood-pressure control, regular dilated eye examinations, and timely laser, injection, or surgical treatment reduce risk.

**Diabetes During Pregnancy (Gestational Diabetes)**

Alternate index label for Gestational Diabetes.

**Diabetes Pre (Prediabetes)**

Alternate index label for Prediabetes.

**Diabetes Symptoms In Men**

Diabetes in men may cause thirst, frequent urination, fatigue, blurred vision, slow wound healing, recurrent infections, erectile dysfunction, or loss of sensation. Some people have no symptoms, so risk-based blood testing is important.

**Diabetes Symptoms In Women**

Diabetes in women may cause thirst, frequent urination, fatigue, blurred vision, recurrent vaginal or urinary infections, slow wound healing, or pregnancy complications. Symptoms can be absent, and screening depends on age, risk factors, and pregnancy status.

**Diabetes Treatment**

Diabetes treatment combines nutrition, physical activity, glucose monitoring, education, and medicines chosen for the type of diabetes and individual risks. Care also addresses blood pressure, lipids, kidneys, eyes, nerves, feet, vaccines, and cardiovascular health.

**Diabetes Type 1 (Type 1 Diabetes)**

Alternate index label for Type 1 Diabetes.

**Diabetes Type 2 (Type 2 Diabetes)**

Alternate index label for Type 2 Diabetes.

**Diabetic Diet For Type 2 Diabetes**

A type 2 diabetes eating plan emphasizes consistent carbohydrate awareness, fiber-rich foods, adequate protein, unsaturated fats, and portions that support glucose and weight goals. There is no single diabetic diet; medicines, kidney function, culture, and preferences guide the plan.

**Diabetic Home Care And Monitoring**

Home diabetes care may include checking glucose, taking medicines, inspecting feet, recognizing low or high glucose, recording results, and attending eye, kidney, dental, and cardiovascular follow-up. Sick-day plans and ketone guidance are important for people at risk of ketoacidosis.

**Diarrhea IBS (IBS-D Irritable Bowel Syndrome With Diarrhea)**

Alternate index label for IBS-D Irritable Bowel Syndrome with Diarrhea.

**Diarrhea Travelers (Traveler's Diarrhea)**

Alternate index label for Traveler's Diarrhea.

**Diet Diabetes (Diabetic Diet)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Diet.

**Diet IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention)**

Alternate index label for Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention.

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### **Diet Ulcerative Colitis (Ulcerative Colitis Diet)**

Alternate index label for Ulcerative Colitis Diet.

### **Difficile C. Contagious (Is C Diff Clostridium Difficile Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is C diff Clostridium difficile Contagious.

### **Difficile Clostridium (Clostridium Difficile Colitis)**

Alternate index label for Clostridium Difficile Colitis.

### **Difficulty Swallowing (Swallowing)**

Alternate index label for Swallowing.

### **Diffuse Idiopathic Skeletal Hyperostosis**

Diffuse idiopathic skeletal hyperostosis causes flowing calcification and ossification along spinal ligaments and may affect peripheral entheses. It can produce stiffness, pain, swallowing difficulty, or fractures after minor trauma; management is symptom-focused and addresses associated metabolic risks.

#### **Synonyms:**

DISH (Diffuse Idiopathic Skeletal Hyperostosis)

### **Diphtheria Facts**

Diphtheria is a toxin-producing infection, usually of the throat or skin, caused by *Corynebacterium diphtheriae*. A gray membrane, neck swelling, nerve injury, heart inflammation, and airway obstruction can occur; vaccination, isolation, antitoxin, and antibiotics are central to treatment.

### **Direct Vs Indirect Hernia**

A direct inguinal hernia pushes through a weak area of the abdominal wall medial to the inferior epigastric vessels, while an indirect hernia follows the inguinal canal through the deep ring. Both may cause a groin bulge and can become incarcerated or strangulated.

#### **Synonyms:**

Indirect Vs. Direct Hernia (Direct Vs Indirect Hernia)

### **DISH (Diffuse Idiopathic Skeletal Hyperostosis)**

Alternate index label for Diffuse Idiopathic Skeletal Hyperostosis.

### **Dislocated Ankle (Ankle Dislocation)**

Alternate index label for Ankle Dislocation.

### **Dislocated Elbow**

An elbow dislocation occurs when the joint surfaces lose alignment, usually after a fall or collision. It causes severe pain, deformity, and limited movement and requires urgent reduction with assessment of nerves, blood vessels, fractures, and later stiffness.

### **Dislocated Hip**

A hip dislocation is displacement of the femoral head from the acetabulum, usually after major trauma or around a prosthetic joint. It is an emergency because blood supply to the femoral head and nearby nerves can be compromised.

### **Dislocated Knee**

A knee dislocation is loss of alignment between the femur and tibia, often after high-energy trauma. Artery and nerve injury may be occult, so urgent reduction and vascular assessment are required even when the joint spontaneously relocates.

### **Disorder Antisocial Personality (Antisocial Personality Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Antisocial Personality Disorder.

### **Disorder Asperger (Asperger Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Asperger Syndrome.

### **Disorders Sleep (Sleep)**

Alternate index label for Sleep.

### **Disorders Sleep In Children (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.



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## Disorders Sleep In Teenagers (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

## Dissection Aorta (Aortic Dissection)

Alternate index label for Aortic Dissection.

## Diverticulosis Vs Diverticulitis

Diverticulosis is the presence of pouches in the colon wall and may cause no symptoms or bleeding. Diverticulitis occurs when a pouch becomes inflamed or infected, causing localized pain, fever, bowel changes, or complications such as abscess or perforation.

## Divisum Pancreas (Pancreas Divisum)

Alternate index label for Pancreas Divisum.

## Dizziness (Dizzy)

Alternate index label for Dizzy.

## Dizziness: Causes, Symptoms, And Treatment

Dizziness may mean vertigo, lightheadedness, imbalance, or a floating sensation. Causes include inner-ear disease, dehydration, medication, anemia, heart rhythm problems, migraine, anxiety, or neurologic disease; treatment depends on the pattern and examination.

## Dizziness: When To See A Doctor?

Dizziness needs urgent assessment when it begins suddenly or occurs with weakness, numbness, trouble speaking, severe headache, chest pain, fainting, inability to walk, persistent vomiting, or new hearing loss. Recurrent or unexplained dizziness also merits evaluation.

## Dog Bite Treatment

Dog-bite care includes thorough wound cleaning, assessment of tissue and tendon injury, tetanus review, rabies-risk evaluation, and antibiotics when indicated. Deep punctures, bites to the hand or face, uncontrolled bleeding, infection, or immune compromise require prompt medical care.

## Synonyms:

Bite Dog (Dog Bite Treatment)

## Dog Bite

An injury caused by a dog's teeth. Care includes prompt wound cleansing, assessment for tissue damage and infection, tetanus review, and evaluation of rabies exposure when relevant.

## Synonyms:

Dog bite injury

## Dos And Donts During First Trimester Of Pregnancy

First-trimester care includes prenatal visits, recommended folic acid, avoidance of alcohol and tobacco, medication review, food-safety precautions, and appropriate activity. Severe pain, heavy bleeding, fainting, fever, or persistent vomiting needs urgent obstetric evaluation.

## Double Vision

Double vision may arise from an eye alignment problem, corneal or lens disease, muscle or nerve dysfunction, medication, migraine, or brain disease. Sudden double vision, especially with weakness, speech change, severe headache, or eye pain, is an emergency.

## Doula Vs. Midwife

A doula provides nonmedical emotional, informational, and physical support during pregnancy, birth, and postpartum care. A midwife is a licensed clinician who provides medical maternity care within training and local scope, including assessment and management of normal pregnancy and birth.

## Down Syndrome Overview

Down syndrome is a genetic condition caused by an extra chromosome 21 and is associated with characteristic features, developmental differences, hypotonia, and variable heart, hearing, vision, thyroid, gastrointestinal, and sleep conditions. Lifelong individualized health and developmental support is beneficial.

## Synonyms:

Trisomy 21 (Down Syndrome Overview)

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### Drug Induced Liver Disease

Drug-induced liver injury occurs when a medicine, supplement, or toxin damages liver cells or bile flow. It may cause fatigue, nausea, itching, dark urine, jaundice, or no symptoms; identifying and stopping the responsible exposure under medical guidance is central to care.

### Dry Scalp Vs. Dandruff (Dandruff Vs Dry Scalp)

Alternate index label for Dandruff vs Dry Scalp.

### Dry Socket Overview

Dry socket is painful inflammation after a tooth extraction when the protective blood clot is lost or breaks down before healing. Pain often worsens several days after extraction and may radiate to the ear; dental cleaning, medicated dressing, and analgesia provide relief.

#### Synonyms:

Alveolar Osteitis (Dry Socket Overview)

### Dryness Vaginal (Vaginal Dryness And Vaginal Atrophy)

Alternate index label for Vaginal Dryness and Vaginal Atrophy.

### Duck Syndrome

Duck syndrome is an informal term for appearing successful while privately experiencing severe stress, anxiety, exhaustion, or depression. It is not a formal diagnosis; persistent distress, impaired functioning, or self-harm thoughts warrant mental-health evaluation and support.

### Duodenal Diverticulum

A duodenal diverticulum is an outpouching of the duodenal wall, often found incidentally near the ampulla. It can rarely cause pain, bleeding, inflammation, obstruction, pancreatitis, or bile-duct infection and is treated according to symptoms and complications.

### Dupuytren's Contracture (Dupuytren

### Contracture)

Alternate index label for Dupuytren Contracture.

### DVT (Deep Vein Thrombosis)

Alternate index label for Deep Vein Thrombosis.

### Dwarfism (Achondroplasia)

Alternate index label for Achondroplasia.

### Dysplasia Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia)

Alternate index label for Cervical Dysplasia.

### D & C

Dilation and curettage, a procedure in which the cervix is widened and tissue is removed from the uterine cavity for treatment or diagnosis.

### D.O.

Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine, a physician degree whose graduates are licensed to practice medicine and surgery like MD graduates in the United States.

### Dacryo-

A combining form meaning tear or tear duct.

### Dactyl-, -Dactyl

A combining form or suffix meaning finger or toe.

### Daily Value

A reference amount used on U.S. Nutrition Facts labels to show how much a nutrient in one serving contributes to a typical daily diet.

### Daw

An abbreviation meaning dispense as written, indicating that the pharmacist should dispense the prescribed product rather than automatically substitute a generic equivalent when permitted by law.

### De Musset Sign

Rhythmic head bobbing with the heartbeat, classically associated with severe aortic regurgitation.

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## **DEA**

The U.S. Drug Enforcement Administration, which enforces controlled-substance laws and assigns registration numbers to authorized prescribers and dispensers.

## **Debride**

To remove dead, damaged, infected, or contaminated tissue from a wound or body site to support healing and control infection.

## **Debulk**

To reduce the size or amount of a tumor or other abnormal tissue, usually by surgery or another treatment, without necessarily removing every abnormal cell.

## **Decompression**

Reduction of pressure on a tissue or body compartment, such as removing pressure from a spinal nerve, draining an obstructed organ, or treating pressure changes after diving.

## **Decubitus**

A lying or reclining position; the term also appears in decubitus ulcer, a pressure injury caused by prolonged pressure and shear.

## **Defecation Syncope**

Fainting during or immediately after defecation, usually a situational reflex involving straining, reduced venous return, and a temporary fall in blood pressure.

## **Deficiency, FAO**

Fatty-acid oxidation deficiency, an inherited metabolic disorder in which cells cannot properly use fatty acids for energy, potentially causing fasting- or illness-triggered hypoglycemia, muscle injury, or cardiomyopathy.

## **Deficiency, Iron**

Inadequate iron stores or availability, which can impair hemoglobin production and cause iron-deficiency anemia, fatigue, pallor, and reduced ex-

ercise tolerance.

## **Deficiency, UDP-Glucuronosyltransferase**

Reduced activity of the enzyme that conjugates bilirubin in the liver; inherited forms include Gilbert syndrome and the more severe Crigler–Najjar syndromes.

## **Deformation**

An alteration in the shape or structure of a body part, tissue, or material caused by developmental forces, injury, disease, pressure, or mechanical stress.

## **DEHP**

Di(2-ethylhexyl) phthalate, a plasticizer used in some medical and consumer products; exposure is monitored because of potential reproductive, developmental, and endocrine effects.

## **Demarcation**

A clear boundary separating one area, tissue, process, or condition from another, such as the line between viable and necrotic tissue.

## **Demonophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of demons or supernatural beings.

## **Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever (DHF)**

A severe form of dengue characterized by increased vascular permeability, thrombocytopenia, bleeding manifestations, and potential plasma leakage; current classifications generally use the term severe dengue.

## **Dengue Shock Syndrome**

Life-threatening circulatory shock caused by severe dengue with plasma leakage and reduced effective blood volume, often accompanied by bleeding or organ dysfunction.

## **Dental Braces (Orthodontics)**

Fixed or removable orthodontic appliances that apply controlled forces to move teeth and correct malocclusion or jaw-related alignment problems.

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### **Dental Pain (Toothache)**

Pain arising from a tooth or nearby tissues, commonly due to dental caries, pulp inflammation, infection, trauma, cracked teeth, or gum disease.

### **Denver Developmental Screening Test**

A developmental screening tool for young children that assesses personal-social, fine-motor, language, and gross-motor skills; it screens for possible delay and is not a diagnostic test.

### **Deoxyhemoglobin**

Hemoglobin that is not bound to oxygen; increased levels in superficial blood can contribute to bluish cyanotic coloration.

### **Department Of Health And Human Services**

The U.S. federal department responsible for major public-health, human-services, biomedical research, and health-insurance programs.

### **Depigmentation**

Loss or reduction of normal pigment, especially melanin in the skin, hair, or mucosa, caused by conditions such as vitiligo, inflammation, injury, or treatment.

### **Dermal**

Relating to the dermis, the connective-tissue layer of skin beneath the epidermis.

### **Dermatologic**

Relating to the skin, hair, nails, or the medical specialty of dermatology.

### **Dermatosis**

A disease or disorder of the skin, including inflammatory, infectious, allergic, genetic, and neoplastic conditions.

### **Dermoid Cyst Of The Ovary**

A usually benign mature cystic teratoma arising from germ cells in the ovary and containing tissues such as skin, hair, fat, or teeth.

### **DES**

An abbreviation that may mean diethylstilbestrol, a synthetic estrogen, or drug-eluting stent; diethylstilbestrol exposure during pregnancy is associated with later reproductive and cancer risks.

### **Desiccate**

To dry out or remove moisture from a tissue, substance, or environment.

### **Designer Steroid**

A chemically modified anabolic-androgenic steroid created to produce performance-enhancing effects or evade detection; products may be unapproved, contaminated, and medically dangerous.

### **Desmoplastic Reaction**

Formation of dense fibrous connective tissue in response to tissue injury or, commonly, invasion by a carcinoma.

### **Desmoplastic Trichoepithelioma**

A rare benign follicular adnexal tumor, usually a small solitary facial papule or annular lesion, that can resemble morpheaform basal-cell carcinoma and is distinguished by histopathologic examination.

### **Desmoplastic Melanoma**

A rare spindle-cell melanoma with prominent fibrous stroma, usually arising on chronically sun-damaged skin; it may be amelanotic and can be difficult to recognize clinically and histologically.

### **Digital Papillary Adenocarcinoma**

A rare malignant sweat-gland tumor, usually arising on a finger, hand, or foot as a slow-growing nodule; it can recur locally and metastasize.

### **Desquamation**

Shedding or peeling of the outer layers of skin or another epithelial surface.

### **Development**

The progressive process by which an organism, organ, or ability grows, differentiates, and acquires

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structure or function.

### **Developmental Disorder**

A condition beginning during the developmental period that affects physical, intellectual, language, learning, behavioral, or social functioning.

### **Dextro-**

A combining form meaning right, toward the right, or sometimes clockwise.

### **Dextroposition Of The Heart**

Displacement of the heart toward the right side of the chest, usually because of an external shift such as lung disease or abnormal anatomy; it is distinct from dextrocardia.

### **Dextrose**

D-glucose, a simple sugar used by cells for energy and given medically in oral or intravenous solutions to treat or prevent low blood glucose.

### **DHA**

Docosahexaenoic acid, an omega-3 polyunsaturated fatty acid important in neural and retinal membranes and obtained from seafood or supplements.

### **DHEA**

Dehydroepiandrosterone, an adrenal steroid precursor that can be converted into androgens and estrogens; its levels vary with age and disease.

### **DHF (Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever)**

An abbreviation for dengue hemorrhagic fever, a severe dengue presentation involving vascular leakage, thrombocytopenia, bleeding, and possible shock.

### **DHHS**

The abbreviation for the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services.

### **Di-**

A combining form meaning two, twice, or double.

### **Dia-**

A combining form with meanings including through, across, apart, or complete, depending on the word.

### **Dialysis Machine**

Equipment that circulates blood or dialysis fluid across a semipermeable membrane to remove waste, excess fluid, and electrolytes when kidney function is inadequate.

### **Diaphragm (Muscle)**

A dome-shaped skeletal muscle separating the chest from the abdomen; contraction enlarges the thoracic cavity and drives inhalation.

### **Diastolic**

Relating to diastole, the phase when the heart muscle relaxes and the chambers fill; diastolic blood pressure is the lower number in a blood-pressure reading.

### **Diff Dx**

Abbreviation for differential diagnosis, the reasoned comparison of possible causes of a patient's signs, symptoms, or test findings.

### **Differentiated Cancer**

A cancer whose cells retain recognizable structural or functional features of the tissue from which they arose; the degree of differentiation helps describe tumor grade.

### **Difficult Urination**

Trouble starting or maintaining urine flow, painful urination, weak stream, or incomplete emptying; causes include infection, obstruction, neurologic disease, and pelvic or prostate disorders.

### **Dioscorides**

A first-century Greek physician and pharmacologist whose work *De materia medica* described medicinal plants and substances and influenced pharmacology for centuries.

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## **Diphallia**

A rare congenital condition in which a person has duplication of the penis, sometimes accompanied by abnormalities of the urinary or digestive tract.

## **Dipper**

A person whose blood pressure falls normally during sleep, usually by about 10

## **Diprosopus**

A rare congenital craniofacial duplication in which parts or all of the face are duplicated, usually associated with severe developmental abnormalities.

## **Dipsophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of drinking alcohol or of becoming intoxicated.

## **Dipsosis**

Excessive thirst, which may result from dehydration, increased blood osmolality, diabetes, medication effects, or disorders of thirst regulation.

## **Disc**

A thin, round structure; in the spine, an intervertebral disc is a fibrocartilaginous cushion between adjacent vertebral bodies.

## **Discharge**

Fluid released from a body site, such as a wound or vagina, or the release of a patient from medical care; the color, amount, and context determine significance.

## **Discoïd Lupus**

A chronic form of cutaneous lupus causing round, inflamed, scaly plaques that may scar, alter pigmentation, and cause permanent hair loss on the scalp.

## **Discordance**

Lack of agreement or correspondence between findings, measurements, genetic results, or the conditions of two related people.

## **Discordant**

Not agreeing, matching, or corresponding; in medicine it may describe conflicting test results or differing conditions in related individuals.

## **Discordant Couple**

A couple in which partners differ in a relevant medical status, such as one partner having HIV infection and the other not having it.

## **Disease Nomenclature**

The system of names and classification terms used to identify, describe, and organize diseases and related clinical conditions.

## **Disease Surveillance**

Ongoing, systematic collection, analysis, interpretation, and reporting of health data to detect, monitor, and respond to disease patterns.

## **Disease, Osgood-Schlatter**

Overuse-related traction injury of the tibial tubercle growth area in growing children or adolescents, causing activity-related pain and swelling below the knee.

## **Disease, Subclinical**

Disease that produces no obvious symptoms or signs but can be detected by laboratory tests, imaging, or other evaluation.

## **Disordered Thinking**

A disturbance in the organization, coherence, logic, or flow of thought that may occur with psychiatric illness, neurologic disease, substances, delirium, or other medical conditions.

## **Distention**

Enlargement or stretching of an organ, cavity, or body part, as in abdominal distention from gas, fluid, obstruction, or swelling.

## **Disto-**

A combining form meaning distal, distant, or away from a point of attachment or origin.



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### **Disulfaram-Like Reaction**

An unpleasant reaction after alcohol is consumed with disulfiram or another interacting substance, potentially causing flushing, headache, nausea, vomiting, low blood pressure, or palpitations.

### **Diurnal**

Relating to daytime or occurring within a 24-hour daily cycle.

### **DLI**

Donor lymphocyte infusion, administration of lymphocytes from a stem-cell donor after transplantation to enhance graft-versus-leukemia effects or treat relapse; it can cause graft-versus-host disease.

### **DM**

Most commonly diabetes mellitus, a group of disorders with chronically elevated blood glucose; in other contexts it may have another expansion.

### **DM2**

Type 2 diabetes mellitus, a disorder characterized by insulin resistance and progressive impairment of insulin secretion.

### **DNA Amplification**

Production of many copies of a DNA sequence, naturally or through laboratory methods such as polymerase chain reaction, for detection, analysis, or research.

### **DNS**

An abbreviation that may mean deviated nasal septum or dextrose in normal saline; the intended expansion depends on the clinical context.

### **DOB**

Date of birth, the calendar date on which a person was born.

### **Doc**

Informal shorthand for doctor, a person with a professional qualification to practice medicine or another health profession.

### **Doctor**

A person who has completed an appropriate professional program and is licensed or authorized to practice medicine; the title may also be used for other doctoral-level professionals.

### **Doctors' Symbol**

The Rod of Asclepius, a single snake around a staff, is the traditional symbol of medicine; it is often confused with the two-snake caduceus.

### **Dol**

A historical unit intended to quantify subjective pain intensity; modern clinical practice uses validated pain scales rather than the dol.

### **Dolor**

Latin for pain; it is one of the classic signs of inflammation.

### **Domain**

A defined region or area of function; in biology, a protein domain is a structural or functional part of a protein, while in genetics it may mean a genomic or regulatory region.

### **Dopa-Responsive Dystonia (DRD)**

An inherited movement disorder with dystonia and sometimes parkinsonism that improves markedly with low-dose levodopa.

### **Doraphobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of animal fur, skin, or contact with hairy surfaces.

### **Dorsum**

The back or upper surface of a body part, such as the dorsum of the hand, foot, or tongue.

### **DOTS**

Directly observed treatment, short-course, a tuberculosis-control strategy in which health workers observe medication doses and monitor treatment response and adherence.

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## **Douglas, Pouch Of**

The rectouterine pouch, a peritoneal recess between the uterus and rectum; in people without a uterus, the related rectovesical pouch lies between the bladder and rectum.

## **Downregulation**

A decrease in the number, sensitivity, or activity of receptors, genes, or signaling pathways in response to sustained stimulation or other regulation.

## **DPT**

An older abbreviation for the combined diphtheria, pertussis, and tetanus vaccine; current formulations include DTaP and Tdap.

## **DPT Immunization**

Immunization against diphtheria, pertussis, and tetanus, now generally given in age-appropriate DTaP or Tdap formulations.

## **DR Syndrome**

An abbreviation that may refer to diabetic retinopathy syndrome or another context-specific disorder; the full clinical term should be specified.

## **Drain**

A tube or other device used to remove blood, pus, fluid, or air from a wound, body cavity, or organ; drain can also mean the act of removing it.

## **DRE (Digital Rectal Exam)**

An examination in which a gloved, lubricated finger is inserted into the rectum to assess the rectal wall, stool, prostate, tenderness, masses, or bleeding.

## **Dreams**

Subjective experiences, images, thoughts, or emotions occurring during sleep, especially during rapid-eye-movement sleep.

## **Drip**

A drop-by-drop flow of liquid or an intravenous infusion delivered at a controlled rate through tubing and a catheter.

## **Drop Hand Syndrome**

Weakness or paralysis of wrist and finger extension, usually from radial-nerve injury or compression, causing the hand to hang in flexion.

## **Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA)**

The U.S. agency responsible for enforcing controlled-substance laws and regulating aspects of their manufacture, distribution, and prescribing.

## **Drug, Prescription**

A medicine legally supplied under the order of an authorized prescriber, with its indication, dose, duration, interactions, and risks specified for the patient.

## **Drug, Sulfa**

A sulfonamide drug; some are antibacterial medicines, while others are used as diuretics or for other indications, and sulfonamide reactions vary by drug and patient.

## **Drugs, Statin**

Medicines that inhibit HMG-CoA reductase and lower LDL cholesterol, reducing the risk of atherosclerotic cardiovascular events.

## **DSM**

The Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, a classification and diagnostic reference published by the American Psychiatric Association.

## **DT**

An abbreviation that may mean delirium tremens or diphtheria–tetanus vaccine; the intended meaning depends on context.

## **DTaP**

A childhood vaccine protecting against diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis, containing diphtheria and tetanus toxoids and acellular pertussis components.

## **DTC**

An abbreviation that may mean differentiated thyroid carcinoma or direct-to-consumer, such as direct-

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to-consumer genetic testing; the intended meaning depends on context.

### **DTP**

An older abbreviation for diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis vaccine; current childhood formulations are generally called DTaP.

### **Duloxetine**

A serotonin–norepinephrine reuptake inhibitor used for depression, anxiety, diabetic peripheral neuropathic pain, fibromyalgia, and some chronic musculoskeletal pain.

### **Dumdum Fever**

An older name for visceral leishmaniasis, a parasitic disease that can cause prolonged fever, enlarged spleen and liver, low blood counts, and weight loss.

### **Duodenal**

Relating to the duodenum, the first portion of the small intestine immediately beyond the stomach.

### **Dupuytren, Guillaume**

A French surgeon whose name is associated with Dupuytren contracture, progressive thickening and shortening of palmar fascia that bends the fingers toward the palm.

### **Dura**

The dura mater, the tough outermost membrane surrounding the brain and spinal cord.

### **Dural Sac**

The tubular sleeve of dura mater surrounding the spinal cord, cerebrospinal fluid, and spinal nerve roots within the vertebral canal.

### **DV**

An abbreviation that may mean domestic violence, ductus venosus, or another context-specific term; the full expression should be specified.

### **Dyad**

A pair of related people, structures, cells, or vari-

ables considered together.

### **DYS**

An abbreviation or word root related to dysplasia, dystonia, dyslexia, or another condition beginning with dys-; the intended meaning depends on context.

### **Dys-**

A prefix meaning abnormal, difficult, painful, or impaired, as in dysphagia (difficulty swallowing) and dysuria (painful urination).

### **Dysfunction**

Abnormal, impaired, or inadequate function of an organ, tissue, system, or process.

### **Dyspeptic**

Relating to dyspepsia, symptoms such as upper-abdominal discomfort, fullness, early satiety, belching, or nausea.

### **Dysphoria**

A state of marked unease, dissatisfaction, or emotional distress; gender dysphoria specifically refers to distress related to incongruence between experienced gender and assigned sex.

### **Dust Mite Allergy**

An allergic reaction to proteins from household dust mites, commonly causing sneezing, congestion, itchy eyes, or asthma symptoms.

### **Drug Addiction (Substance Use Disorder)**

A chronic disorder involving compulsive substance use despite harmful consequences, with impaired control, cravings, tolerance, or withdrawal.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chemical Dependency Substance Abuse Disorder

### **Depression (Major Depressive Disorder)**

A mood disorder causing persistent depressed mood or loss of interest along with cognitive, physical, and functional symptoms.

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### **Dry Gangrene**

Tissue death caused mainly by loss of arterial blood supply, producing dry, shrunken, dark tissue with a relatively clear boundary from viable tissue.

### **Digitate Warts (Verruca Digitata)**

Filiform or finger-like warts, usually arising on the face or neck and caused by HPV infection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Verruca Digitata

### **Da Costa's Syndrome**

Da Costa's Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Day Hospital**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning day hospital; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Day-Blindness**

A biomedical term referring to day-blindness; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Day-Sickness**

A clinical condition or finding involving day-sickness. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **DDAVP**

A clinical condition or finding involving ddavp. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deaf-Mutism**

A clinical condition or finding involving deaf-mutism. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deaner**

A clinical condition or finding involving deaner. Its

defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Death Certificate**

A clinical condition or finding involving death certificate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Death Rate**

A clinical condition or finding involving death rate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Decerebrate Rigidity**

A clinical condition or finding involving decerebrate rigidity. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deciduous Teeth**

Deciduous Teeth is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

### **Defaecation**

Defaecation is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

### **Defence Mechanisms**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning defence mechanisms; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Deficiency Diseases**

Deficiency Diseases is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Definition Of Health**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning definition of health; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

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## Degeneration

Degeneration is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## Déjà Vu

A clinical condition or finding involving déjà vu. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Delta Agent

A clinical condition or finding involving delta agent. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Dental Floss

Dental Floss is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

## Deodorant

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning deodorant; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

## Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA)

Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA) is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## Depilación

A clinical condition or finding involving depilación. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Depot Injection

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to depot injection; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Depressed Fracture

A biomedical term referring to depressed fracture; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Depressive Illness

A clinical condition or finding involving depressive illness. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Deprivation

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning deprivation; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

## Derbyshire Neck

Derbyshire Neck is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

## Dercum's Disease

Dercum's Disease is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

## Dermatoglyphics

Dermatoglyphics is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

## Dermatophyte

Dermatophyte is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

## Desferrioxamine

Desferrioxamine is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

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### **Desmoid Tumour**

A clinical condition or finding involving desmoid tumour. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Developmental Disorders**

Developmental Disorders is a developmental, psychological, or behavioral concept; assessment considers age, duration, functional impact, medical causes, and social context.

### **Developmental Milestone**

A clinical condition or finding involving developmental milestone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Deviation**

Deviation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Dexamphetamine**

Dexamphetamine is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Dexibuprofen**

A medicine called dexibuprofen. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Dexketoprofen**

A clinical condition or finding involving dexketoprofen. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dextrin**

A clinical condition or finding involving dextrin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dextropropoxyphene**

A clinical condition or finding involving dextropropoxyphene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diabetogenic**

A clinical condition or finding involving diabetogenic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diabrosis**

A biomedical term referring to diabrosis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Diacritics**

A clinical condition or finding involving diacritics. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diagnostic Imaging**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess diagnostic imaging. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Diamorphine**

A medicine called diamorphine. Its uses, dosing, adverse effects, and contraindications depend on the specific indication and patient.

### **Diarrhoea**

A clinical condition or finding involving diarrhoea. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diastase**

A clinical condition or finding involving diastase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diastasis**

Diastasis is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.



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### **Dibenzepin**

A clinical condition or finding involving dibenzepin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dichloralphenazone**

A clinical condition or finding involving dichloralphenazone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dicoumarol**

A clinical condition or finding involving dicoumarol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dicrotic**

A clinical condition or finding involving dicrotic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dictation Machine**

A clinical condition or finding involving dictation machine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dicumarol**

A clinical condition or finding involving dicumarol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dienoestrol**

A clinical condition or finding involving dienioestrol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dietary Fibre**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning dietary fibre; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Diethylcarbamazine**

Diethylcarbamazine is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the

specific agent and patient.

### **Diethylstilbestrol Dipropionate**

Diethylstilbestrol Dipropionate is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Dieting**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning dieting; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Difference Threshold**

A clinical condition or finding involving difference threshold. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Differential Blood Count**

A clinical condition or finding involving differential blood count. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dihydrocodeine**

A clinical condition or finding involving dihydrocodeine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dihydroergotamine**

A clinical condition or finding involving dihydroergotamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dilatation And Curettage (D & C)**

Dilatation and Curettage (D & C) is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

### **Dilution**

Dilution is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

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### **Dimethyl Sulphoxide (DMSO)**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimethyl sulphoxide (dmso). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dimocillin**

Dimocillin is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Dimorphic**

A clinical condition or finding involving dimorphic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diethyl Sodium Sulphosuccinate**

A clinical condition or finding involving diethyl sodium sulphosuccinate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diodone**

A clinical condition or finding involving diodone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dioecious**

A clinical condition or finding involving dioecious. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dionin**

Dionin is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Diplacuis**

A clinical condition or finding involving diplacuis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Diplococcus**

Diplococcus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Dipole**

A clinical condition or finding involving dipole. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dipsomania**

A biomedical term referring to dipsomania; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Direct Action**

Direct Action is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Direct Hernia**

A clinical condition or finding involving direct hernia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dirt-Eating**

A clinical condition or finding involving dirt-eating. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Disaccharidase**

A clinical condition or finding involving disaccharidase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Discolysis**

Discolysis is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Discoloration**

Discoloration is a medical or biological term de-

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scribing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Discomfort**

Discomfort is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Disinfestation**

Disinfestation is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Disorganized Schizophrenia**

Disorganized Schizophrenia is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

### **Dispensary**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning dispensary; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dispensing**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning dispensing; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dispersal**

Dispersal is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Displacement**

Displacement is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Disseminated Sclerosis**

Disseminated Sclerosis is an anatomical structure,

body position, physical finding, or physiological process; its clinical meaning depends on the examination and surrounding findings.

### **Distemper**

A clinical condition or finding involving distemper. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Distension**

Distension is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Distichia**

Distichia is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Distilling**

Distilling is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Distortion**

Distortion is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **District Nurse**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning district nurse; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dizygotic Twins**

Dizygotic Twins is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

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### **Doctor-Patient Relationship**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning doctor-patient relationship; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dolichocephalic**

Dolichocephalic is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Donnan Equilibrium**

Donnan Equilibrium is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Donor**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning donor; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dopamine Agonists**

Dopamine Agonists is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Dormant**

Dormant is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Dorsiflexion**

Dorsiflexion is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

### **Dorzolamide**

Dorzolamide is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Dosimeter**

A clinical condition or finding involving dosimeter. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Dotage**

Dotage is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Double Blind Trial**

A clinical condition or finding involving double blind trial. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Down's Syndrome**

Down's Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Draft**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning draft; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Drastic**

Drastic is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Draw-Sheet**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning draw-sheet; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dreamy State**

Dreamy State is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

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## **Drepanocytosis**

Drepanocytosis is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Dressler's Syndrome**

Dressler's Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

## **Drift**

Drift is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Drops**

Drops is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Dropsy**

A clinical condition or finding involving dropsy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Drug**

Drug is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Drug Addiction**

Drug Addiction is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Drug Safety**

Drug Safety is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and

patient.

## **Dry Cupping**

Dry Cupping is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Duboisin**

Duboisin is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Duck Embryo Vaccine**

Duck Embryo Vaccine is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Ductal Carcinoma**

A clinical condition or finding involving ductal carcinoma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Ductless Glands**

Ductless Glands is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

## **Ductus Venosus**

Ductus Venosus is an anatomical structure, physiologic process, or body function; its location or mechanism explains its clinical relevance.

## **Dupuytren's Contracture**

Dupuytren's Contracture is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

## **Duramorph**

Duramorph is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and

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patient.

### **Durules**

Durules is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Dust Disease**

Dust Disease is a chemical, environmental, or toxicology term; health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Dynamic**

A clinical care, prevention, behavioral, or public-health concept concerning dynamic; its use depends on the patient, setting, and clinical goal.

### **Dysaesthesia**

Dysaesthesia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dyschezia**

Dyschezia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dysfunctional Uterine Bleeding**

Dysfunctional Uterine Bleeding is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dysorexia**

Dysorexia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dyspraxia**

Dyspraxia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on

the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dysraphism**

Dysraphism is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dysrhythmia**

Dysrhythmia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dysthymia**

Dysthymia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Dystociais**

Dystociais is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; diagnosis and management depend on the history, examination, and appropriate investigations.

### **Discoïd**

Coin-shaped or round, describing the morphology of a lesion or rash; the term may also refer to discoïd lupus erythematosus in the appropriate clinical context.

### **Distribution**

The anatomical pattern and sites affected by a skin lesion or rash, including whether involvement is localized, generalized, symmetrical, flexural, extensor, dermatomal, or otherwise characteristic.

### **DPP-4 Inhibitor**

An oral glucose-lowering drug that inhibits dipeptidyl peptidase-4, prolonging the action of incretin hormones and increasing glucose-dependent insulin release while reducing glucagon secretion. It is used mainly in type 2 diabetes.



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### Diabetologist

A physician who specializes in the prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of diabetes and its complications, including glucose management, cardiovascular risk, kidney disease, neuropathy, and retinopathy.

### DKD

Alternate index label; see *Diabetic Nephropathy*.

### Diffuse Parenchymal Lung Diseases

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial Lung Disease*.

### Diffusion Capacity

A measure of how efficiently oxygen and other gases pass from the air sacs into the pulmonary capillary blood; commonly reported as DLCO and reduced in many interstitial and vascular lung disorders.

### DIEP Flap

A deep inferior epigastric perforator flap used for breast or other reconstruction, consisting of skin and fat supplied by perforating vessels from the lower abdomen while preserving most of the rectus muscle.

### Dermatofibrosarcoma Protuberans Of The Breast

A rare, usually slow-growing cutaneous sarcoma involving breast skin or superficial tissue. It is locally infiltrative, has a high risk of local recurrence if incompletely removed, and typically shows COL1A1-PDGFB fusion.

### Desmoplastic Fibroblastoma

A rare benign collagen-rich fibroblastic tumor, also called collagenous fibroma, presenting as a slow-growing painless mass in superficial or deep soft tissue.

### Desmoplastic Infantile Ganglioglioma

A rare low-grade tumor of infancy containing astrocytic and neuronal components in a desmoplastic stroma, usually presenting as a large superficial cerebral mass with seizures or increased intracranial pressure.

### Dysembryoplastic Neuroepithelial Tumor

A benign or very low-grade glioneuronal tumor, usually in the cerebral cortex of children or young adults, classically causing long-standing drug-resistant focal seizures.

### Demyelinating Disease Of The Central Nervous System

A disorder in which myelin is damaged within the brain, spinal cord, or optic pathways, impairing nerve conduction. Causes include autoimmune, infectious, genetic, toxic, and metabolic processes.

### Dichorionic Diamniotic Twin Placenta

A twin-placentation pattern in which each fetus has its own chorion and amniotic sac. It is usually associated with the lowest placental complication risk among twin pregnancies, although maternal and fetal monitoring remains necessary.

### Detritic Synovitis

A synovial inflammatory reaction to particulate debris, such as cartilage, bone, blood, crystals, or implant wear material, producing joint swelling and pain.

### Diabetic Microvascular Complications

Small-vessel complications of diabetes, principally retinopathy, nephropathy, and neuropathy, caused by chronic metabolic and vascular injury; risk is reduced by glycemic, blood-pressure, and lipid control.



## E

### E Coli Enteritis

Intestinal infection caused by pathogenic strains of *Escherichia coli*. Depending on the strain, it may cause watery or bloody diarrhea, abdominal cramps, vomiting, or systemic complications such as hemolytic uremic syndrome.

### EBCT

Electron-beam computed tomography, a rapid imaging method used especially to assess the heart and calcium in coronary arteries.

#### Synonyms:

Electron-beam computed tomography

### Eccentric Action

Muscle action in which a muscle produces force while lengthening.

#### Synonyms:

Eccentric contraction

### ECG

A recording of the heart's electrical activity used to evaluate rhythm and other cardiac problems.

#### Synonyms:

Electrocardiogram; EKG

### ED

Erectile dysfunction: inability to obtain or maintain an erection adequate for sexual activity.

#### Synonyms:

Erectile dysfunction

### EEG

An EEG records electrical activity generated by the brain through scalp electrodes and helps evalu-

ate seizures, encephalopathy, and selected sleep or neurologic disorders.

#### Synonyms:

Electroencephalogram

### Eighth Cranial Nerve

The vestibulocochlear nerve, which carries hearing and balance signals from the inner ear to the brain.

#### Synonyms:

Vestibulocochlear nerve; auditory nerve

### EKG

A recording of the heart's electrical activity.

#### Synonyms:

Electrocardiogram; ECG

### Elastin

A flexible connective-tissue protein that allows skin, blood vessels, and other tissues to stretch and recoil.

### Electrolysis

Permanent hair removal using electrical energy delivered through a fine probe into a hair follicle.

### Electrolyte

A mineral that carries an electrical charge in body fluids, such as sodium, potassium, or calcium.

### Electron-Beam Computed Tomography

A rapid computed-tomography technique used to image the heart and detect calcium deposits in arteries.

#### Synonyms:

EBCT

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### **Elimination Diets**

Diets in which suspected foods are removed and later reintroduced to help identify food-related symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

Elimination diet

### **Ellagic Acid**

A plant-derived polyphenol found in foods such as berries and nuts.

### **Emetic**

A substance that induces vomiting.

### **EMG**

A test that evaluates muscle activity and the nerves controlling muscles.

**Synonyms:**

Electromyography

### **Emmenagogue**

A substance traditionally used to stimulate menstrual flow.

### **Encoding**

The process by which sensory or cognitive information is converted into a form that can be stored in memory.

### **Endogenous Opioids**

Pain-relieving opioid peptides produced naturally by the body.

**Synonyms:**

Endogenous opioid peptides

### **Endorphins**

Natural opioid peptides that reduce pain and can contribute to feelings of well-being.

**Synonyms:**

Endogenous opioids

### **Endothelins**

Peptides made by vascular endothelium that constrict blood vessels and can raise blood pressure.

### **Endothelium-Derived Relaxing Factor**

A substance released by the endothelium that relaxes blood vessels; it is largely identified with nitric oxide.

**Synonyms:**

EDRF; Nitric oxide

### **Enkephalin**

An endogenous opioid peptide involved in reducing pain.

**Synonyms:**

Endogenous opioid

### **Enteropathic**

Relating to disease of the intestine.

### **Eosinophils**

White blood cells involved in allergic inflammation and defense against some parasites.

**Synonyms:**

Eosinophil granulocytes

### **Epicondylitis**

Painful inflammation or degeneration of a tendon attachment near a joint epicondyle, commonly at the elbow.

**Synonyms:**

Tennis elbow; golfer's elbow

### **Epidemiological Study**

A population-based investigation of disease occurrence, causes, risks, or health outcomes.

**Synonyms:**

Epidemiologic study

### **Epinephrine**

A hormone and neurotransmitter that increases heart activity and narrows many blood vessels during stress.

**Synonyms:**

Adrenaline

### **Epithelial Cells**

Cells that cover body surfaces and line organs, cav-

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ities, and glands.

**Synonyms:**

Epithelial tissue cells

**Erector Spinae**

A group of muscles running along the back that extend and stabilize the spine.

**Synonyms:**

Erector spinae muscles

**Ergots**

Compounds derived from a fungus and used in some treatments, including certain headache disorders.

**Eructation**

The release of swallowed or stomach gas through the mouth.

**Synonyms:**

Belching; burping

**Essential Fats**

Fatty acids that the body cannot make in sufficient amounts and must obtain from food.

**Synonyms:**

Essential fatty acids

**Esterified Estrogens**

Estrogen compounds used in some hormone treatments.

**Esthetician**

A person trained in nonmedical skin-care and cosmetic treatments.

**Synonyms:**

Aesthetician

**Estradiol**

The principal biologically active estrogen hormone during the reproductive years.

**Synonyms:**

17 $\beta$ -estradiol

**Estrogen Receptor**

A cellular protein that binds estrogen and mediates

its effects on target tissues.

**Estrogen-Replacement Therapy**

Treatment using estrogen to replace hormone lost during menopause or because of ovarian failure.

**Synonyms:**

Estrogen therapy

**Etidronate**

A bisphosphonate used in selected conditions involving abnormal bone remodeling.

**Euthyroid**

Having normal thyroid function.

**Exceptional Release**

Regulatory process allowing use of an organ that does not meet standard criteria but is deemed acceptable for a specific recipient after informed consent.

**Excitatory Neurotransmitter**

A chemical messenger that increases the likelihood that a receiving neuron will generate a signal.

**Excitotoxin**

A substance that overstimulates neurons and can injure or kill them.

**Executive Functions**

Mental abilities used to plan, organize, make decisions, control impulses, and adapt behavior.

**Synonyms:**

Executive control

**Exercise**

Planned physical activity performed to improve or maintain fitness and health.

**Synonyms:**

Physical exercise

**Exostosis**

A benign bony growth; in the ear canal, repeated cold-water exposure can cause surfer's ear.

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**Synonyms:**  
Surfer's ear

### Experience Sampling

A research method that collects brief reports about a person's activities or feelings at randomly selected times.

**Synonyms:**  
Ecological momentary assessment

### Expression Hopping

A shift from one manifestation of an addiction to another, such as from substance use to compulsive gambling.

### Expression Of Addiction

The particular behavior or substance through which an addiction is manifested.

### Extend

To straighten a joint or increase the angle between bones.

**Synonyms:**  
Extension

### Extracapsular Cataract Surgery

Cataract surgery that removes the cloudy lens while leaving the lens capsule largely in place.

### Extract

A concentrated preparation made by drawing active substances from a plant, herb, or other source.

**Synonyms:**  
Extractive

### Extrinsic Factor

An outside influence that affects a person, tissue, or biological process.

**Synonyms:**  
External factor

### E Coli Infection

Infections caused by *Escherichia coli*, a gram-negative enteric bacillus. Causes: UTI (most common—cystitis, pyelonephritis), diarrhea (enterotoxi-

genic ETEC—traveler's diarrhea; enteropathogenic; enterohemorrhagic EHEC O157:H7—bloody diarrhea, HUS; enteroinvasive), neonatal meningitis, sepsis, and intra-abdominal infections.

### Ear

Organ of hearing and balance, divided into external, middle, and inner ear. External: auricle (pinna), external auditory canal, tympanic membrane. Middle: air-filled cavity in temporal bone, auditory ossicles (malleus, incus, stapes), Eustachian tube (to nasopharynx).

### Ear Barotrauma

Injury to the ear caused by a pressure difference between the middle ear and the surrounding environment, commonly during air travel or diving. It may cause ear pain, fullness, hearing loss, tinnitus, vertigo, or tympanic-membrane rupture.

### Ear Canal

A tube leading from the eardrum to the outer ear.

### Ear Diseases

Any disorder affecting the structures of the ear—external ear (pinna, ear canal), middle ear (tympanic membrane, ossicles, Eustachian tube), or inner ear (cochlea, vestibular apparatus).

### Ear Infection

Infection or inflammation of the ear, commonly involving the external canal or middle ear. It may cause ear pain, fever, reduced hearing, discharge, or irritability in children. Also called otitis.

**Synonyms:**  
otitis. Otitis (Ear Infection)

### Ear Wax

Cerumen, a mixture of secretions and shed skin that protects and cleans the ear canal. Impacted wax may cause hearing loss, fullness, tinnitus, itching, or discomfort. Cotton swabs and inserted objects can worsen impaction or injure the ear; removal should use safe clinician-recommended methods, particularly when an eardrum perforation is possible.



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**Synonyms:**

Earwax (Ear Wax)

**Ear, Nose, And Throat**

A medical specialty (otolaryngology) focused on the diagnosis and treatment of disorders affecting the ears, nose, throat, head, and neck. Conditions managed include hearing loss, sinusitis, tonsillitis, voice disorders, and head and neck cancers.

**Earache**

Earache (otalgia) is pain perceived in or around the ear. Causes include ear infection, ear-canal blockage or injury, dental or jaw disorders, and referred throat disease; persistent, severe, or discharge-associated pain requires evaluation.

**Earache (Otalgia)**

Pain originating from the ear, a common symptom with diverse causes. Otalgia is classified as primary (originating within the ear itself) or secondary/referred (pain perceived in the ear but arising from another site).

**Synonyms:**

Otalgia

**Eardrum**

A thin membrane separating the ear canal and middle ear.

**Ear Foreign Body**

An object lodged in the external auditory canal, commonly occurring in children. It may cause pain, hearing reduction, discharge, or canal injury and should be removed with appropriate visualization and technique.

**Synonyms:**

External auditory-canal foreign body; ear-canal foreign body.

**Early Decelerations**

A fetal heart-rate pattern with a gradual decrease and recovery that mirrors the uterine contraction, usually caused by fetal head compression. It is generally benign when isolated, but the complete

tracing and clinical situation determine whether any action is needed.

**Early Detection**

Identification of a disease at an early stage, when treatment may be more effective. It may result from screening or prompt evaluation of symptoms.

**Early Intervention**

Services provided to infants and young children with developmental delays or disabilities to support development, function, and participation.

**Earwax**

Cerumen, a waxy secretion produced by the ceruminous glands in the outer third of the external auditory canal. Earwax lubricates and protects the skin of the ear canal, trapping dust, debris, and microorganisms to prevent them from reaching the tympanic membrane.

**Eating Disorder**

A group of conditions characterized by abnormal eating habits and distorted body image, including anorexia nervosa, bulimia nervosa, binge eating disorder, and avoidant/restrictive food intake disorder (ARFID). Anorexia: severe calorie restriction, intense fear of weight gain, and body image disturbance with dangerously low weight.

**Ebola**

Ebola virus disease (EVD): a severe, often fatal viral hemorrhagic fever caused by Ebola virus (Filoviridae, RNA), transmitted by direct contact with blood/body fluids of infected humans/animals. Incubation 2-21 days.

**Ebola Virus**

A filovirus that causes Ebola virus disease, a severe hemorrhagic fever. The virus is transmitted through contact with infected body fluids. The incubation period is 2-21 days. Symptoms include fever, headache, myalgia, and hemorrhage. Diagnosis is made by PCR and antigen detection.

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## **Ebola Virus Disease**

A severe viral infection caused by Ebola viruses, characterized by fever and systemic illness that may progress to bleeding, shock, or organ failure.

## **Ebstein Anomaly**

A rare congenital heart defect accounting for less than 1 percent of all congenital heart disease, characterized by apical displacement of the septal and posterior leaflets of the tricuspid valve into the right ventricle, resulting in atrialization of the proximal right ventricle and a small functional right ventricular chamber.

## **Ecchymosis**

A flat purple, blue, or brown area caused by blood leaking into skin or subcutaneous tissue, commonly after trauma but also with platelet disorders, anticoagulants, clotting disorders, or fragile blood vessels. Size alone does not determine the cause.

## **Eccrine Gland**

A coiled sweat gland distributed throughout the skin that secretes a watery fluid directly onto the skin surface through a duct. Eccrine sweating supports thermoregulation and is stimulated by sympathetic cholinergic fibres; the glands are especially numerous on the palms, soles, and forehead.

## **ECG/EKG Machine**

Records electrical activity of heart. 12-lead ECG standard. Components: electrodes, leads, amplifier, recorder. Essential for cardiac diagnosis.

## **Echinocandins**

A class of antifungal agents that inhibit beta-1,3-glucan synthase, an enzyme essential for synthesis of beta-1,3-glucan, a major component of the fungal cell wall. This unique mechanism targets a structure absent in mammalian cells, resulting in favorable toxicity profiles.

## **Echinococcal Cysts**

Fluid-filled parasitic cysts caused by larval *Echinococcus* tapeworms, usually occurring in the liver or lungs.

## **Echinococcosis**

A parasitic infection caused by *Echinococcus* tapeworms. Cystic disease commonly affects the liver or lungs, while alveolar disease can invade the liver and spread to other organs; diagnosis and treatment require specialist assessment.

## **Echinococcus Granulosus**

A tapeworm that causes hydatid disease (cystic echinococcosis). The adult worm infects dogs, and humans are accidental intermediate hosts. Infection occurs through ingestion of eggs from dog feces. Larval cysts form in the liver and lungs, causing space-occupying lesions.

## **Echinocytes (Burr Cells)**

Red blood cells with uniform, small, evenly spaced serrated or spiky membrane projections along the entire erythrocyte circumference. Most commonly caused by End-Stage Renal Disease (Uremia), pyruvate kinase deficiency, severe hypokalemia, or in vitro artifact (crenation due to glass slides or prolonged storage).

### **Synonyms:**

Burr Cells

## **Echo**

A common abbreviation for echocardiography, an ultrasound examination used to assess the heart's structure and function.

## **Echocardiogram**

An echocardiogram uses ultrasound to assess cardiac chambers, valves, wall motion, blood flow, and ventricular function without ionizing radiation. It helps evaluate heart failure, valve disease, congenital defects, and other cardiac disorders.

## **Echocardiography**

Ultrasound imaging of the heart, the primary modality for assessing cardiac structure and function. Transthoracic echocardiography (TTE) is the most common approach; transesophageal echocardiography (TEE) provides better views of posterior structures (left atrium, mitral valve, aorta).

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### **Echogenic Bowel**

An ultrasound finding in which the fetal bowel appears unusually bright, sometimes as bright as nearby bone. It may be a normal variant or may be associated with infection, chromosomal conditions, cystic fibrosis, or other fetal abnormalities.

### **Echogenic Intracardiac Focus**

A small bright area, usually in a papillary muscle of the fetal heart, seen on ultrasound. It is commonly an incidental variant when isolated and the remainder of the examination is normal. Its significance depends on prior screening, other ultrasound findings, and the clinical context.

### **Echolalia**

The involuntary, automatic repetition of words or phrases spoken by another person, a speech phenomenon observed in various neurologic and psychiatric conditions. Immediate echolalia involves repeating sounds immediately after hearing them; delayed echolalia involves repeating phrases heard hours, days, or weeks earlier.

### **Echovirus**

A group of enteroviruses that commonly cause asymptomatic or mild infection but may also cause aseptic meningitis, encephalitis, rash, respiratory illness, myocarditis, or neonatal sepsis. Transmission is mainly faecal-oral or respiratory, and diagnosis is usually by nucleic-acid testing or viral culture in selected cases.

### **Eclampsia**

Eclampsia is a new-onset seizure during pregnancy or the postpartum period associated with preeclampsia or pregnancy-related hypertension. It is an emergency requiring airway and blood-pressure management, magnesium sulfate for seizure prevention or treatment, and urgent obstetric planning.

### **ECOG Performance Status**

A five-point scale describing functional impairment, from 0 for fully active to 5 for death. It is widely used in clinical trials, prognostic assessment, and decisions about systemic anticancer treatment.

### **Ecthyma Gangrenosum**

A severe cutaneous infection caused by *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, characterized by painless, hemorrhagic vesicles that rapidly progress to necrotic ulcers with black eschars. It occurs almost exclusively in immunocompromised or neutropenic patients and results from bacterial invasion of blood vessel walls.

### **Ectoderm**

The outermost of the three primary germ layers in an embryo, which develops into the skin, nervous system, and sensory organs.

### **Ectodermal Dysplasia**

A group of inherited disorders affecting tissues derived from the embryonic ectoderm, including hair, teeth, nails, skin, and sweat glands. Findings vary but may include sparse hair, abnormal teeth, reduced sweating, heat intolerance, and recurrent infections.

### **Ectopia Lentis**

Displacement or malposition of the crystalline lens from its normal position, most commonly due to trauma but also associated with systemic conditions including Marfan syndrome (superior displacement), homocystinuria (inferior displacement), and Weill-Marchesani syndrome.

### **Ectopic ACTH Syndrome**

Adrenocorticotrophic hormone secretion by non-pituitary tumors causing Cushing syndrome. Most commonly caused by small cell lung cancer and bronchial carcinoid tumors. Other sources include thymic carcinoid, pancreatic neuroendocrine tumors, and medullary thyroid carcinoma.

### **Ectopic Cushing Syndrome**

Hypercortisolism caused by an extrapituitary tumor producing adrenocorticotrophic hormone or, rarely, corticotropin-releasing hormone. It may cause hypertension, diabetes, hypokalemia, muscle weakness, infection risk, and rapid features of cortisol excess.

### **Ectopic Heartbeat**

A heartbeat originating outside the normal

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sinoatrial-node rhythm. Premature atrial or ventricular beats may feel like a skipped beat, flutter, or sudden thump and can occur in healthy people or with structural heart disease.

### **Ectopic Pregnancy**

Implantation of a fertilized ovum outside the uterine cavity, most commonly in the fallopian tube (95%). Risk factors: prior ectopic, PID, tubal surgery, IUD, smoking, and assisted reproductive technology. Presents with lower abdominal pain, amenorrhea, and vaginal bleeding. Rupture causes hemodynamic instability.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pregnancy Ectopic (Ectopic Pregnancy) Pregnancy Tubal (Ectopic Pregnancy)

### **Ectopic Thyroid**

Thyroid tissue located outside its normal pretracheal position, most commonly along the path of thyroid descent from the foramen cecum to the normal cervical location. The most common site is the base of the tongue (lingual thyroid).

### **Ectopic Thyroid Tissue**

Thyroid tissue located outside the normal pretracheal position resulting from failure of normal thyroid descent during embryological development. Most commonly found at the base of the tongue termed lingual thyroid. May be the only functioning thyroid tissue. Symptoms include dysphagia, dysphonia, and upper airway obstruction.

### **Ectrodactyly**

A congenital limb malformation characterized by a deep median cleft of the hand or foot with missing central digits, resulting in a claw-like or lobster-claw appearance. Also known as split hand/foot malformation (SHFM). Most cases are autosomal dominant with incomplete penetrance, linked to mutations in TP63, DLX5, or WNT10B genes.

### **Ectropion**

Ectropion is outward turning of an eyelid, usually the lower lid, causing tearing, irritation, dryness, and incomplete eyelid closure. It may be involu-

tional, paralytic, cicatricial, or mechanical; persistent corneal exposure can damage vision.

### **Eczema**

A group of inflammatory skin conditions characterized by pruritic, erythematous, scaly patches. Atopic dermatitis is the most common form. Nummular eczema presents as coin-shaped lesions. Dyshidrotic eczema affects palms and soles with vesicles. Eczema herpeticum is a disseminated HSV infection in eczema patients, a medical emergency.

### **Eczema (Atopic Dermatitis)**

A chronic inflammatory skin condition characterized by dry, itchy, and inflamed patches of skin. It is driven by a combination of genetic predisposition, immune system dysfunction, and environmental triggers.

#### **Synonyms:**

Atopic Dermatitis

### **Eczema Herpeticum**

A widespread viral skin infection caused by herpes simplex virus occurring in patients with pre-existing skin barrier defects, most commonly atopic dermatitis. It presents with monomorphic, umbilicated vesicles, pustules, and hemorrhagic crusted erosions, often with fever and lymphadenopathy.

### **Edema**

Swelling caused by excess fluid trapped in body tissues. Types: pitting (press leaves indentation), non-pitting (myxedema, lymphedema). Causes: heart failure, kidney disease, liver cirrhosis, venous insufficiency, lymphatic obstruction, medications (calcium channel blockers, NSAIDs).

### **Edema (Historically Dropsy)**

An historic term for edema, referring to the abnormal accumulation of serous fluid in the tissues or body cavities.

#### **Synonyms:**

historically Dropsy

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## Edentulism

Complete or partial absence of natural teeth. It can impair mastication, speech, nutrition, facial support, and quality of life and may be managed with removable, fixed, or implant-supported prostheses.

## Edward Syndrome

Trisomy 18, a chromosomal condition associated with severe developmental impairment, characteristic hand and foot findings, congenital heart defects, growth restriction, and feeding difficulties. Survival and severity vary, but mortality in infancy is high.

## Edwards Syndrome

Trisomy 18, caused by an extra chromosome 18 in all or some cells or by an unbalanced rearrangement. It is associated with multiple congenital anomalies, severe developmental impairment, and high infant mortality.

### Synonyms:

Trisomy 18 (Edwards Syndrome)

## EFAST Examination

Extended focused assessment with sonography in trauma, a bedside ultrasound examination for intraperitoneal or pericardial free fluid and pneumothorax or hemothorax. It rapidly informs trauma resuscitation but does not exclude all internal injuries when negative.

## Effacement

Thinning (shortening) of the cervix during labor, expressed as a percentage (0-100 percent), as the cervix is taken up into the lower uterine segment, enabling dilation. Occurs with cervical dilation in the first stage of labor, driven by contractions and the presenting part.

## Effective Dose

A radiation-protection quantity that estimates the population-averaged stochastic health risk from nonuniform exposure by weighting absorbed doses to different organs and tissues. It is not a patient-specific prediction of cancer risk.

## Effective Half-Life

The time required for the activity of a radionuclide in a tissue or body to fall by one half through both physical radioactive decay and biologic elimination. It determines the duration of radiation exposure in that compartment.

## Effective Reproduction Number (Rt)

The average number of secondary infections caused by an infectious person at a particular time, accounting for existing immunity, behavior, interventions, and population structure. Sustained transmission generally requires Rt above 1.

### Synonyms:

Rt

## Efficacy

The maximum therapeutic effect a drug or intervention can produce under ideal conditions (e.g., in a clinical trial). Efficacy is determined by the drug's mechanism of action and the receptor-effector system; it is measured by the Emax (maximal effect) on the dose-response curve.

## EGD

Esophagogastroduodenoscopy is an examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum with a flexible endoscope. It can evaluate symptoms or bleeding, obtain biopsies, and provide selected treatments such as hemostasis or removal of a lesion.

## EGFR Inhibition

A targeted cancer therapy using monoclonal antibodies or small-molecule tyrosine kinase inhibitors that block the epidermal growth factor receptor signaling pathway, inhibiting tumor cell proliferation, survival, and metastasis. Used in colorectal cancer, non-small cell lung cancer, and head and neck squamous cell carcinoma.

## Eggshell Nail

A nail that becomes unusually thin, soft, flexible, and sometimes whitish or concave. It may be associated with nutritional deficiency, chronic illness, aging, or repeated trauma; persistent nail changes should be evaluated with the skin and other symp-



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toms in mind.

### **Egophony**

An abnormal vocal sound heard during auscultation in which spoken “E” sounds are heard as “A” (the “E-to-A” change). It is a sign of lung consolidation, as in lobar pneumonia. The consolidated lung tissue conducts high-frequency sounds better than air-filled lung.

### **Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome**

A group of hereditary connective tissue disorders caused by defects in collagen synthesis or processing.

#### **Synonyms:**

EDS (Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome) Elastic Skin (Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome)

### **EHR**

Electronic health record, a digital record of a person’s health information that can include data from multiple clinicians and care settings.

### **Ehrlichia And Anaplasma**

Obligate intracellular bacteria transmitted by ticks that cause ehrlichiosis and anaplasmosis. Ehrlichia chaffeensis causes human monocytic ehrlichiosis. Anaplasma phagocytophilum causes human granulocytic anaplasmosis. The organisms infect white blood cells (Ehrlichia) or granulocytes (Anaplasma).

### **Ehrlichiosis**

Ehrlichiosis is a tick-borne infection caused by Ehrlichia bacteria, commonly producing fever, headache, malaise, low blood counts, and elevated liver enzymes. ehrlichiosis) and E. ewingii (granulocytic). Endemic in the southeastern and south-central US. Presents with fever, headache, myalgia, malaise, and thrombocytopenia/leukopenia.

### **Eisenmenger Syndrome**

Reversal of a left-to-right cardiac shunt due to irreversible pulmonary hypertension, resulting in right-to-left shunting and cyanosis. It occurs in untreated congenital heart defects with large left-to-right shunts (VSD, ASD, PDA) that cause progressive pulmonary vascular disease.

### **Eisenmenger’s Syndrome**

Pulmonary vascular disease caused by a long-standing congenital heart shunt, eventually reversing the shunt and causing cyanosis.

### **Ejaculation**

The expulsion of seminal fluid from the male urethra during sexual climax, a reflex coordinated by the sympathetic nervous system (T10-L2) and involving contraction of the epididymis, vas deferens, seminal vesicles, prostate, and bulbospongiosus muscle.

### **Ejection Click**

A high-pitched sound occurring at the beginning of systole, caused by opening of a stenotic semilunar valve. Aortic ejection click is heard in bicuspid aortic valve and aortic stenosis with pliable leaflets. Pulmonary ejection click is heard in pulmonary stenosis and disappears as the valve becomes more calcified and immobile.

### **Ejection Fraction**

The percentage of blood in a ventricle that is ejected during contraction, calculated from stroke volume and end-diastolic volume. It is used to describe cardiac function, but interpretation depends on the imaging method, clinical findings, and applicable heart-failure definitions.

### **Elastic Cartilage**

Flexible cartilage containing abundant elastic fibers in its matrix. It supports structures that require shape retention with flexibility, including the external ear, epiglottis, and auditory tube.

### **Elastography**

Imaging tissue stiffness. Used for liver fibrosis assessment, breast lesion characterization, thyroid nodule evaluation.

### **Elbow Joint**

A synovial hinge complex comprising the humeroulnar and humeroradial joints. It primarily permits flexion and extension, while the proximal radioulnar component permits forearm rotation.



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## Elder Abuse

Intentional or neglectful act causing harm to older person. Types: physical, emotional, sexual, financial, neglect. Risk factors: social isolation, caregiver stress, cognitive impairment, dependency. Mandatory reporting required. Assessment: direct question, observation, collateral history.

## Elderly

Person aged 65 or older. Divisions: young-old (65-74), middle-old (75-84), old-old (85+). Heterogeneous population with varying health status, needs, preferences.

## Electrical Cardioversion

Delivery of a synchronized electrical shock timed to the R wave to terminate selected tachyarrhythmias, such as atrial fibrillation, atrial flutter, or certain supraventricular tachycardias. Sedation, thromboembolic risk, and the patient's hemodynamic status must be assessed.

## Electrical Injury

Tissue damage caused by passage of electrical current through the body. Severity depends on voltage, current (alternating vs. direct), pathway, duration, and resistance. High-voltage (>1000V): extensive internal tissue damage (muscle necrosis, compartment syndrome, rhabdomyolysis) with relatively small skin burns (entry/exit wounds).

## Electrical Stimulation

The therapeutic application of controlled electrical currents to nerves or muscles. Examples include transcutaneous electrical nerve stimulation for pain and neuromuscular stimulation for selected muscle or movement problems.

## Electrocardiogram

An electrocardiogram records the heart's electrical signals and helps identify rhythm disturbances, conduction disease, ischemia, infarction, and chamber strain.

### Synonyms:

ECG or EKG.

## Electrocardiography

The process of recording the heart's electrical activity from skin electrodes, usually as a 12-lead ECG or EKG. It evaluates heart rate and rhythm, conduction, chamber enlargement, ischemia, infarction, and some electrolyte or drug effects.

## Electrocoagulation

A surgical technique using high-frequency electrical current to destroy tissue or stop bleeding by coagulating proteins, also known as diathermy or cauterization.

### Synonyms:

diathermy or cauterization.

## Electroconvulsive Therapy

A neuromodulation treatment involving the induction of a generalized seizure under general anesthesia using electrical current applied to the scalp. It is the most effective treatment for severe depression, especially with psychotic features, catatonia, or suicidal ideation.

## Electrocution

Injury from electrical current. Types: low voltage (<1000V), high voltage (>1000V). Effects: cardiac arrhythmias, muscle contractions, burns, neurological damage. Management: ABCs, cardiac monitoring, tetanus prophylaxis, wound care, check for compartment syndrome.

## Electroencephalogram

EEG: a recording of electrical activity of the brain via scalp electrodes, reflecting cortical neuronal activity. Uses: diagnosis and classification of seizures/epilepsy (interictal epileptiform discharges, spikes/waves), status epilepticus monitoring, assessment of encephalopathy, sleep disorders, and determination of brain death.

## Electroencephalography

A non-invasive neurophysiological test that records the electrical activity of the brain using electrodes placed on the scalp according to the international 10-20 system.

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## Electrolyte Balance

Homeostasis of sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, chloride, phosphate. Regulated by kidneys, hormones (aldosterone, ADH, PTH). Imbalance causes neuromuscular, cardiac, metabolic dysfunction.

## Electrolyte Imbalance

Abnormal serum concentration of electrolytes (sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, phosphate, chloride). Hyponatremia ( $<135$  mEq/L): most common electrolyte disorder; causes include SIADH, heart failure, hypovolemia, and polydipsia. Hypernatremia ( $>145$  mEq/L): free water deficit from poor intake, diabetes insipidus, or diuretics.

## Electrolytes

Electrically charged minerals in body fluids, including sodium, potassium, chloride, bicarbonate, calcium, magnesium, and phosphate. They support nerve conduction, muscle contraction, fluid balance, and acid-base regulation.

## Electromagnetic Navigation Bronchoscopy

A guidance system for bronchoscopy that uses electromagnetic fields to navigate to peripheral lung lesions. It allows biopsy of lesions not visible on standard bronchoscopy. It is more accurate than conventional transbronchial biopsy for peripheral lesions. It may reduce the need for CT-guided biopsy.

## Electromyography

A test that records the electrical activity of skeletal muscles, often together with nerve-conduction studies, to evaluate peripheral nerve, nerve-root, neuromuscular-junction, and muscle disorders.

## Electron Transport Chain

Series of protein complexes (I-IV) and mobile carriers (ubiquinone, cytochrome c) in the inner mitochondrial membrane that transfer electrons from NADH and FADH<sub>2</sub> to oxygen, pumping protons to create electrochemical gradient used by ATP synthase. Complex I (NADH dehydrogenase): NADH  $\rightarrow$  ubiquinone.

## Electrophysiology Study

Invasive cardiac catheterization with multielectrode catheters placed in the heart to map the cardiac conduction system. Measures: sinus node function (SNRT, SACT), AV node function (AH interval, HV interval), and inducibility of arrhythmias (programmed electrical stimulation).

## Electrosurgical Unit

A generator that delivers high-frequency electrical energy through an active electrode to cut tissue or achieve hemostasis. Monopolar and bipolar configurations differ in current pathway and safety considerations; burns, unintended tissue injury, and interference with implanted devices are possible complications.

## Elephantiasis

Massive enlargement of a body part, typically a limb or the scrotum, caused by chronic lymphedema from obstruction of lymphatic vessels. The most common cause worldwide is lymphatic filariasis, a mosquito-borne parasitic infection by *Wuchereria bancrofti*, *Brugia malayi*, or *Brugia timori*.

## Elevation

Superior movement of a body part, such as raising the mandible or shoulder girdle.

## Elimination Half-Life

Time for plasma concentration to decrease by 50%. Determines dosing interval, accumulation, withdrawal from exposure. Affected by renal/hepatic function, age, drug interactions.

## Embolectomy

Surgical removal of embolus from blood vessel. Indications: acute arterial occlusion, pulmonary embolism. Techniques: Fogarty catheter, open surgical extraction. Often combined with thrombolysis.

## Embolectomy (Vascular)

Removal of an embolus from a blood vessel by surgery or a catheter-based procedure.

**Synonyms:**

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Vascular

### **Embolism**

An embolism is the occlusion of a blood vessel by a detached mass that has traveled through the bloodstream from its site of origin. The most common form is thromboembolism, where a fragment of a thrombus dislodges and travels to a distant site through the venous or arterial circulation.

### **Embolization**

Deliberate occlusion of a blood vessel or vascular malformation using materials such as coils, particles, glue, or plugs. It is used to control hemorrhage, treat aneurysms or malformations, reduce tumor vascularity, or induce organ infarction in selected therapies.

### **Embolization (Vascular)**

Intentional blockage of a blood vessel using a catheter-delivered material to control bleeding, reduce blood flow, or treat a vascular lesion.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Embolization Therapy**

Image-guided occlusion of vessels. Used for hemorrhage control, tumor devascularization, aneurysm treatment, varices.

### **Embryo**

The developing human organism from fertilization through the end of the eighth week after fertilization. From the ninth week after fertilization, it is termed a fetus.

### **Emergence Agitation**

A state of confusion, restlessness, and inconsolable crying during emergence from anesthesia, occurring in 10 to 80 percent of pediatric patients and 5 to 10 percent of adults. Risk factors include sevoflurane induction, short procedures, parental separation, and preexisting behavioral disorders.

### **Emergency Contraception**

Contraception used after unprotected intercourse or contraceptive failure to reduce the chance of pregnancy. Options include oral medicines and a copper intrauterine device; effectiveness depends on the method, timing, medical history, and access to care.

### **Emergency Department**

Hospital department providing immediate medical care for acute illnesses and injuries. Staffed by emergency physicians and supported by specialists. Key principles: triage (prioritize by severity), stabilization, diagnosis, treatment, disposition.

### **Emergency Procedures**

Planned actions for responding to urgent events such as spills, contamination, equipment failure, or radiation exposure while protecting patients and staff.

### **Emerging Infectious Disease**

New or reemerging infectious diseases. Examples: COVID-19, Zika, Ebola, MERS.

### **Emesis**

The forceful expulsion of gastric contents through the mouth, a complex reflex coordinated by the vomiting center in the medulla oblongata.

### **Emetics**

Substances that induce vomiting. They are generally not used to treat poisoning because vomiting may cause aspiration or additional injury.

### **Emission**

The discharge or release of a substance, usually a fluid. In male reproduction, emission refers to the movement of semen into the posterior urethra in preparation for ejaculation.

### **Emotional Eating**

Eating in response to emotions such as stress, boredom, or sadness rather than primarily in response to physical hunger. Cognitive behavioral therapy

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may help.

### **Emphysema**

A form of COPD characterized by permanent, abnormal enlargement of airspaces distal to the terminal bronchioles, accompanied by destruction of their walls. Centriacinar emphysema affects the respiratory bronchioles and is associated with smoking.

### **Emphysematous Aortitis Due To Clostridium Septicum**

A rare, life-threatening infection of the aortic wall by *Clostridium septicum*, characterized by gas formation within the aortic wall visible on imaging. It typically occurs in immunocompromised patients and may present with sepsis, back pain, or aortoenteric fistula.

### **Emphysematous Cholecystitis**

A severe, gas-forming infection of the gallbladder wall caused by anaerobic organisms, most commonly *Clostridium* species and *Escherichia coli*, occurring predominantly in diabetic men. Gas within the gallbladder wall or lumen is visible on imaging. It is a surgical emergency requiring urgent cholecystectomy and broad-spectrum antibiotics.

### **Emphysematous Hepatitis**

A rare, life-threatening gas-forming infection of the liver parenchyma, most commonly caused by *Clostridium* species or mixed enteric organisms in immunocompromised or diabetic patients. Imaging reveals gas within the liver parenchyma.

### **Emphysematous Prostatitis**

A rare, severe gas-forming infection of the prostate gland, most commonly caused by *Escherichia coli* in diabetic or immunocompromised patients. It presents with fever, perineal pain, urinary retention, and sepsis. Imaging shows gas within the prostatic parenchyma.

### **Emphysematous Pyelonephritis**

Severe necrotizing infection of renal parenchyma with gas formation. Almost exclusively in diabetic patients. Presents with high fever, flank pain, and

sepsis. CT shows gas within renal parenchyma. A urological emergency requiring aggressive antibiotics and usually nephrectomy.

### **Empty Calories**

A nontechnical term for foods or drinks that provide substantial energy but relatively few vitamins, minerals, fiber, or other beneficial nutrients.

### **Empty Sella Syndrome**

Herniation of subarachnoid space into the sella turcica, compressing the pituitary gland and flattening it against the sellar floor. Primary: due to congenital weakness of the diaphragma sella. Secondary: post-surgery, post-radiation, or pituitary apoplexy (Sheehan syndrome). Most are asymptomatic.

### **Empyema**

A collection of pus in a normally sterile body cavity, most often infected pleural fluid around the lung, causing fever, chest pain, cough, and breathlessness.

### **Empyema Necessitans**

Extension of pleural empyema through the chest wall. Presents as a painful, fluctuant mass. Requires drainage and antibiotics.

### **EMR**

Electronic medical record, a digital record of health information maintained within a particular health-care organization or practice.

### **Enamel**

Hard, highly mineralized outer layer of tooth crown. Avascular, aneural, cannot regenerate. Enamel hypoplasia causes defects. Dental caries begins in enamel. Fluoride strengthens enamel.

### **Enamel Hypoplasia**

Defective enamel quantity due to systemic disturbance during development. Pits, grooves, or thin enamel.

### **Enamel Pearl**

Small mound of enamel on root surface. Usually

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bifurcation area of molars. May interfere with periodontal attachment.

### **Encapsulating Peritoneal Sclerosis**

Rare condition characterized by a thick fibrocollagenous membrane encasing the small intestine, leading to recurrent bowel obstruction. Most commonly associated with long-term peritoneal dialysis but also seen after abdominal surgery, radiation, and beta-blocker use.

### **Encephalitis**

Encephalitis is inflammation of brain tissue, often infectious or autoimmune, causing altered mental status, seizures, fever, focal deficits, or movement abnormalities. fever, headache, altered mental status, seizures, or focal neurologic deficits and requires urgent medical evaluation.

### **Encephalocele**

A neural tube defect where brain tissue and meninges herniate through a skull defect, most commonly in the occipital region. The herniated sac contains cerebrospinal fluid, meninges, and often brain tissue. Associated with other CNS anomalies including hydrocephalus and Chiari malformation. Presents as a visible, pulsatile midline mass.

### **Encephalopathy**

Any diffuse disease of the brain that alters its structure or function, presenting with a global change in mental status (confusion, lethargy, personality change, coma) rather than focal neurologic deficits.

### **Encopresis**

Repeated passage of stool into inappropriate places by a child beyond the expected toilet-training age, usually associated with chronic constipation and fecal retention.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stool Holding

### **End-Of-Life Care**

Care focused on comfort, symptom control, communication, and support for a person with advanced illness and for their family or caregivers.

### **End-Stage Kidney Disease**

The advanced stage of chronic kidney disease in which the kidneys can no longer adequately maintain fluid, electrolyte, and waste balance. Treatment requires dialysis or kidney transplantation, together with management of complications.

### **End-Stage Renal Disease**

The final stage of chronic kidney disease (CKD stage 5), defined by GFR  $<15$  mL/min/1.73

m<sup>2</sup> or the need for renal replacement therapy. Uremia develops with accumulation of toxins causing nausea, anorexia, pruritus, pericarditis, encephalopathy, and bleeding diathesis.

#### **Synonyms:**

ESRD

### **Endemic**

Regular presence of a disease or infectious agent in a particular population or geographic area at an expected baseline level.

### **Endemic Fungi**

Fungi that occur naturally in particular geographic regions and can cause infection in people who inhale their spores.

### **Endobronchial Foreign Body**

A foreign object lodged in a bronchus, causing partial or complete airway obstruction. It may cause localized wheezing, atelectasis, and post-obstructive pneumonia. It is most common in children and may be initially misdiagnosed as asthma. Bronchoscopy is both diagnostic and therapeutic.

### **Endobronchial Tumor**

A tumor growing within the bronchial lumen, causing obstruction, atelectasis, and post-obstructive pneumonia. It may be malignant (lung cancer, carcinoid tumor) or benign (hamartoma, papilloma). Symptoms include cough, hemoptysis, and wheezing. Treatment is bronchoscopic removal or debulking plus definitive therapy.



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## Endobronchial Ultrasound

Bronchoscopy with ultrasound guidance for trans-bronchial needle aspiration of mediastinal and hilar lymph nodes. Essential for lung cancer staging. Less invasive than mediastinoscopy.

## Endobronchial Valve

A one-way valve placed bronchoscopically in a target airway to achieve lobar atelectasis in emphysema. It allows air and secretions to exit but prevents air from entering. It is used for bronchoscopic lung volume reduction in selected patients with heterogeneous emphysema and intact fissures.

## Endocardial Cushion Defect

A congenital heart defect caused by abnormal development of the atrioventricular cushions, producing an atrioventricular septal defect with abnormal atrioventricular valves. It is strongly associated with Down syndrome and may cause heart failure and pulmonary hypertension.

## Endocarditis

Endocarditis is infection or inflammation of the endocardium, usually involving heart valves, and may cause fever, emboli, valve destruction, and heart failure. Acute bacterial endocarditis: *Staph aureus* (most common in IV drug users and prosthetic valves), rapid destruction. Subacute: viridans group streptococci (pre-existing valve disease).

### Synonyms:

Inflammation Of The Heart Valve (Endocarditis)

## Endocarditis Prophylaxis

Infective endocarditis prophylaxis with antibiotics is recommended for patients at highest risk of adverse outcomes from endocarditis who are undergoing dental procedures that involve manipulation of gingival tissue, the periapical region of teeth, or perforation of the oral mucosa.

## Endocarditis Surgical Indications

Surgery indicated for: heart failure from valve dysfunction, uncontrolled infection (abscess, fistula, vegetation >10 mm with persistent emboli), fungal endocarditis, prosthetic valve dehiscence, and large

vegetations (>15 mm) with embolic events.

## Endocardium

The innermost layer of the heart wall, a thin membrane of endothelial cells and underlying connective tissue that lines the cardiac chambers and covers the heart valves. The endocardium is continuous with the endothelium of blood vessels and provides a smooth, non-thrombogenic surface.

## Endocrine Disrupting Chemicals

Environmental chemicals that interfere with endocrine function including bisphenol A, phthalates, pesticides, and polychlorinated biphenyls. Potential associations with diabetes, obesity, thyroid dysfunction, reproductive disorders, and hormone-sensitive cancers. Evidence is strongest for associations with type two diabetes and obesity.

## Endocrine Disruptor

Chemical interfering with hormone systems. Examples: BPA, phthalates, DDT, PCBs. Effects: reproductive disorders, developmental problems, cancer.

## Endocrine Glands

Ductless glands that secrete hormones directly into the bloodstream to regulate distant target organs.

## Endocrine Therapy

Systemic treatment that manipulates hormones or their receptors in hormone-sensitive cancers, including tamoxifen, aromatase inhibitors, luteinizing hormone-releasing hormone agonists, and antiandrogens.

## Endocrinology

The branch of medicine concerned with the study, diagnosis, and treatment of disorders of the endocrine system—the network of glands that secrete hormones regulating metabolism, growth and development, tissue function, sexual function, reproduction, sleep, and mood.

## Endocytosis

Process by which cells internalize extracellular mate-



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rial by engulfing it with the cell membrane, forming intracellular vesicles. Phagocytosis ("cell eating") involves engulfing large particles (>0.5 micrometers) such as bacteria or debris, forming a phagosome that fuses with lysosomes for digestion.

### **Endoderm**

The innermost germ layer in an embryo, which develops into the linings of the digestive and respiratory tracts, as well as the liver and pancreas.

### **Endodontic Therapy (Root Canal)**

Treatment of dental pulp disease or necrosis. Indications: irreversible pulpitis, pulp necrosis, periapical abscess. Procedure: access cavity, locate canals, clean and shape, obturate with gutta-percha, seal. Success rate: >90%. Alternative: extraction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Root Canal

### **Endoleak**

Persistent blood flow into an aneurysm sac after endovascular aneurysm repair. Type I and III endoleaks reflect inadequate sealing or device failure and generally require urgent correction; other types are managed according to sac expansion and risk.

### **Endometrial Cancer**

The most common gynecologic malignancy in developed countries, arising from the lining of the uterine cavity, typically in postmenopausal women.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Endometrial Cancer, Uterine

### **Endometrial Hyperplasia**

Abnormal overgrowth of the lining of the uterus, often related to prolonged estrogen exposure without enough progesterone. It may cause heavy, irregular, or postmenopausal bleeding; atypical forms can precede endometrial cancer and require gynecologic evaluation, often including endometrial sampling.

### **Endometrioma**

A chocolate cyst of the ovary formed by ectopic endometrial tissue that hemorrhages cyclically, ap-

pearing as a homogenous low-level echo mass on ultrasound and associated with chronic pelvic pain and infertility.

### **Endometriosis**

Endometriosis is growth of endometrial-like tissue outside the uterus, commonly causing pelvic pain, painful periods, pain with intercourse, infertility, or bowel and bladder symptoms. endometrial-like tissue (glands and stroma) outside the uterine cavity, most commonly implanted on the pelvic peritoneum, ovaries, uterosacral ligaments, and rectovaginal septum.

#### **Synonyms:**

Implants Endometrial (Endometriosis)

### **Endometritis**

Inflammation or infection of the uterine lining, often associated with childbirth, miscarriage, abortion, or uterine instrumentation.

### **Acute Endometritis**

Acute inflammation of the endometrium, usually caused by ascending infection or retained tissue after pregnancy-related events or uterine instrumentation; fever, pelvic pain, and abnormal bleeding may occur.

### **Chronic Endometritis**

Persistent low-grade inflammation of the endometrium, often associated with infection, retained products, intrauterine devices, or reproductive failure; plasma cells support the diagnosis histologically. Risk factors include prolonged labor, multiple vaginal examinations, premature rupture of membranes, and cesarean section. Presents with fever, uterine tenderness, foul-smelling lochia, and leukocytosis.

### **Endometrium**

The lining of the uterus.

### **Endophthalmitis**

A severe inflammation, usually infectious, inside the eye that can rapidly threaten vision and requires urgent ophthalmic treatment. aqueous humor, and adjacent structures, representing an ophthalmologic

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emergency.

### **Endoplasmic Reticulum**

Interconnected network of membranous tubules and sacs continuous with the nuclear envelope. Rough ER: studded with ribosomes, site of synthesis of secretory, membrane, and lysosomal proteins; co-translational insertion into ER lumen.

### **Endoprosthesis**

Internal prosthetic device. Vascular stent-grafts, airway stents.

### **Endorphin**

Endogenous opioid peptides (beta-endorphin, enkephalins, dynorphins) produced by the pituitary, hypothalamus, and immune cells that bind opioid receptors (mu, delta, kappa) to produce analgesia, euphoria, and modulation of pain perception and stress responses.

### **Endoscope**

A flexible or rigid instrument with a light and camera used to inspect an internal body passage or cavity and sometimes perform procedures. bronchoscope, colonoscope, gastroscope, arthroscope, cystoscope. Essential for diagnosis and intervention.

### **Endoscopic Mucosal Resection**

Advanced endoscopic technique for removal of superficial gastrointestinal neoplasms by lifting the lesion through submucosal injection and resecting with an electrosurgical snare.

### **Endoscopic Retrograde Cholangiopancreatography**

Combined endoscopic and fluoroscopic procedure used to visualize and treat disorders of the biliary and pancreatic ducts. A duodenoscope is advanced to the second portion of the duodenum and the ampulla of Vater is cannulated. Contrast dye is injected under fluoroscopic guidance creating cholangiograms and pancreatograms.

### **Endoscopic Submucosal Dissection**

Advanced endoscopic technique for en bloc resection of large gastrointestinal neoplasms using specialized electrosurgical knives to dissect through the submucosa. The technique allows complete histological assessment and is particularly valuable for early gastric and colorectal cancers.

### **Endoscopic Ultrasound**

Combined endoscopy and ultrasound for high-resolution imaging of the GI wall and adjacent structures. Linear echoendoscope: allows FNA of mediastinal, pancreatic, and peripancreatic lesions. Radial echoendoscope: 360-degree view for staging GI cancers (TNM staging).

### **Endoscopy**

Examination of an internal body passage or cavity with an endoscope; tissue sampling and treatment may be performed during the procedure. endoscopes. Upper endoscopy examines the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum. Colonoscopy examines the colon and terminal ileum. Both allow direct visualization, biopsy, and therapeutic interventions including polypectomy, hemostasis, and dilation.

### **Endosteum**

The thin connective tissue membrane lining the inner surface of bone, including the medullary cavity, Haversian canals, and trabeculae. Contains osteoprogenitor cells and osteoblasts, contributing to bone formation, remodeling, and repair (fracture healing).

### **Endothelin Receptor Antagonists**

Medications that block endothelin-1, a potent vasoconstrictor implicated in pulmonary arterial hypertension. Bosentan (dual ERA), ambrisentan (selective ETA), and macitentan are used for PAH. Side effects include hepatotoxicity (bosentan), anemia, and teratogenicity.

### **Endotracheal Intubation**

Placement of a cuffed tube through the mouth or nose into the trachea to maintain airway patency, deliver positive-pressure ventilation, administer in-

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haled anesthetics, and protect the airway in selected patients. Correct position must be confirmed clinically and with exhaled carbon dioxide when circulation is present.

### **Endotracheal Tube**

A tube placed through the mouth or nose into the trachea to maintain an airway and support ventilation. A cuff may seal the airway around the tube.

### **Endovascular**

Located within or performed through the interior of a blood vessel, usually using a catheter-based technique.

### **Endovascular Aneurysm Repair**

Minimally invasive technique for abdominal aortic aneurysm repair using stent graft. Accessed via femoral arteries. Advantages: lower perioperative mortality, faster recovery. Disadvantages: need for surveillance, endoleak risk, may require reintervention.

### **Endovascular Graft**

A fabric-covered vascular prosthesis placed through a catheter to reinforce a diseased vessel or exclude an aneurysm. It is used in selected aortic and peripheral vascular conditions; anatomy, symptoms, operative risk, and imaging surveillance determine suitability and follow-up.

### **Endovascular Repair**

A minimally invasive procedure that uses a catheter-delivered graft or other device to repair a blood vessel from inside its lumen.

### **Endurance**

Aerobic capacity, muscular endurance. Cardiorespiratory fitness testing.

### **Enema**

The introduction of fluid into the rectum and colon through the anus for diagnostic or therapeutic purposes.

### **Energy Conservation**

Strategies that reduce unnecessary energy expenditure and fatigue during daily activities, such as pacing, prioritizing, planning, positioning, and using adaptive equipment.

### **Energy Resolution**

The ability of a radiation detector to distinguish photons with different energies, commonly expressed as the width of a photopeak relative to its energy.

### **Energy Window**

The selected range of photon energies accepted by a gamma camera or other radiation detector for image formation. Appropriate selection helps limit scattered radiation.

### **Engagement**

The descent of the fetal presenting part into the pelvis, typically occurring 2-3 weeks before labor in nulliparas or at the onset of labor in multiparas.

### **Enhanced Recovery After Surgery**

A multimodal, evidence-based perioperative pathway that reduces surgical stress and supports early recovery through preoperative counseling, appropriate fasting, opioid-sparing analgesia, early mobilization, early nutrition, and prevention of complications.

### **Enhancement Artifact**

Ultrasound artifact from fluid-filled structures. Enhanced by harmonic imaging.

### **Enhancer**

DNA sequence increasing transcription of target gene, can be distant from gene, orientation-independent. Binds activator proteins. Examples: LCR (locus control region) for beta-globin.

### **Enrichment**

Restoration of nutrients lost during processing. Examples: enriched flour, restored B vitamins.

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## Entamoeba Histolytica

A protozoan parasite that causes amoebiasis, a gastrointestinal and extra-intestinal infection transmitted via the fecal-oral route. The organism exists in two forms: the infectious cyst (transmitted in contaminated food or water) and the invasive trophozoite.

## Enteral Formula

A nutritionally complete or modular liquid preparation delivered into the gastrointestinal tract. Formulas may be polymeric, semi-elemental, or elemental and are selected according to digestion, absorption, fluid, renal, hepatic, and metabolic requirements.

## Enteral Nutrition

Delivery of nutrients via gastrointestinal tract. Routes: nasogastric, nasoduodenal, gastrostomy (PEG), jejunostomy. Indications: dysphagia, neurological disease, head/neck cancer, prolonged inability to eat. Complications: aspiration, diarrhea, tube displacement, sinusitis.

## Enteric Duplication Cyst

A congenital, smooth-muscle-lined cyst arising from the gastrointestinal tract, most commonly in the ileum, containing ectopic gastric or intestinal mucosa. It may present in childhood with abdominal pain, obstruction, or gastrointestinal bleeding from ectopic gastric acid secretion.

## Enteritis

Inflammation of the small intestine caused by infection, inflammatory disease, radiation, reduced blood flow, or other injury. (bacterial, or parasitic). Viral enteritis (norovirus, rotavirus, adenovirus, astrovirus) presents with acute onset of watery diarrhea, nausea, vomiting, and abdominal cramps, typically self-limited over 2–7 days.

## Enterobacteriaceae Carbapenem Resistance

Resistance to carbapenem antibiotics in Enterobacteriaceae, primarily through production of carbapenemases. The most important carbapenemases include KPC, NDM, and OXA-48-like enzymes.

Carbapenem-resistant Enterobacteriaceae (CRE) are a major public health threat due to limited treatment options.

## Enterobiasis

Intestinal infection with the pinworm *Enterobius vermicularis*, commonly causing nighttime itching around the anus.

## Enterobius Vermicularis

A small intestinal nematode commonly called the pinworm or threadworm.

### Synonyms:

the pinworm or threadworm.

## Enterocolitis

Inflammation of both the small intestine and colon, caused by infection, immune-mediated disease, reduced blood flow, toxins, or other injury. It may produce abdominal pain, diarrhoea, fever, vomiting, bleeding, dehydration, or systemic illness; diagnosis and management depend on the cause and severity.

## Enterohepatic Circulation

Recycling of toxins between liver and intestine via bile. Prolonged exposure, increased toxicity. Interrupted by activated charcoal, cholestyramine. Examples: morphine, digoxin, estrogen, thyroxine.

## Enteropathic Arthritis

Inflammatory arthritis associated with inflammatory bowel disease, including Crohn disease and ulcerative colitis. It may affect the spine, sacroiliac joints, or peripheral joints.

## Enterovirus D68

An enterovirus that usually causes respiratory illness but can rarely cause severe pneumonia or acute flaccid myelitis, especially in children; spread occurs through respiratory secretions.

## Enthesis

The site at which a tendon, ligament, or joint capsule attaches to bone.

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## Enthesitis

Inflammation at the site where a tendon, ligament, or joint capsule inserts into bone (enthesitis), a hallmark of spondyloarthritis (ankylosing spondylitis, psoriatic arthritis, reactive arthritis, IBD-associated). Affects Achilles tendon, plantar fascia, patellar, and costochondral junctions.

## Entrance Wound

A skin defect created where a projectile enters the body, distinguished from an exit wound by smaller size, rounded shape, and abraded inward margin. Contact wounds show a muzzle imprint and soot; close-range wounds show soot and powder tattooing; intermediate-range wounds show stippling; distant wounds show a clean abrasion ring.

## Entropion

Inward turning of an eyelid margin, causing eyelashes to rub the eye and produce irritation, tearing, corneal injury, or infection.

## Enuresis

Repeated involuntary urination, usually during sleep in a child who is developmentally expected to remain dry. It may be primary or secondary and requires assessment for constipation, urinary infection, diabetes, sleep or developmental disorders, psychosocial stressors, and lower-urinary-tract dysfunction when clinically indicated.

## Enuresis (Bedwetting)

Repeated involuntary urination during sleep in a child who is developmentally expected to remain dry. It may be primary or secondary; assessment considers constipation, urinary infection, diabetes, sleep disorders, and developmental or psychosocial factors.

### Synonyms:

Bedwetting

## Environmental Health

Study of environmental factors affecting health. Examples: air pollution, water quality, occupational hazards, climate change.

## Enzyme

A protein, or occasionally an RNA molecule, that catalyses a specific biochemical reaction without being consumed; enzyme activity measurements help assess tissue injury, metabolic disease, and drug effects. activation energy. Specificity: lock-and-key or induced fit models. Kinetics: Michaelis-Menten equation ( $V_{max}$ ,  $K_m$ ). Regulation: allosteric control, covalent modification (phosphorylation), proteolytic activation, feedback inhibition.

## Enzyme Induction

A process by which a drug or xenobiotic increases the synthesis or activity of drug-metabolizing enzymes, primarily cytochrome P450 enzymes in the liver, accelerating the metabolism of itself (autoinduction) or other drugs. Enzyme induction typically occurs over days to weeks as it requires new protein synthesis.

## Enzyme Inhibition

A process by which a drug inhibits the activity of drug-metabolizing enzymes, leading to increased plasma concentrations of co-administered drugs that are metabolized by the same enzyme. Enzyme inhibition occurs rapidly (hours to days) as it does not require new protein synthesis.

## Enzyme Kinetics

The study of enzyme-catalyzed reaction rates and the factors that affect them. Important concepts include substrate concentration, maximum reaction rate, binding affinity, inhibitors, and the relationship between enzyme activity and temperature or pH.

## Enzyme-Linked Immunosorbent Assay

An immunoassay that uses an enzyme-labeled antibody or antigen and a substrate-generated signal to detect or quantify a target analyte. It is used for measurement of antibodies, antigens, hormones, cytokines, and infectious disease markers.

## Eosinophil

A granulocyte (1-4 percent of leukocytes) with bilobed nucleus and eosinophilic granules containing major basic protein, eosinophil cationic protein,



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and peroxidase. Roles: defense against parasitic (helminth) infections and modulation of allergic inflammation; contain histaminase and aryl sulfatase.

### **Eosinophilia**

An absolute eosinophil count exceeding 500 cells per microliter in peripheral blood, most commonly caused by parasitic infections, allergic disorders, drug reactions, and autoimmune diseases. Hypereosinophilia, with counts above 1500 per microliter, may cause end-organ damage to the heart, lungs, skin, and nervous system.

### **Eosinophilic Bronchitis**

A cause of chronic cough in which eosinophilic inflammation affects the airways without the variable airflow obstruction typical of asthma. Cough-variant asthma and reflux may mimic it; diagnosis relies on clinical assessment and airway inflammation testing.

### **Eosinophilic Esophagitis**

Chronic immune-mediated condition characterized by dense eosinophilic infiltration of the esophageal mucosa defined as fifteen or more eosinophils per high-power field, in the absence of other causes of esophageal eosinophilia.

### **Eosinophilic Fasciitis**

A rare inflammatory disorder causing painful swelling and progressive thickening of fascia and skin, often with increased blood eosinophils. thickening of the deep fascia and adjacent muscle, presenting with painful swelling and induration of the extremities and a peau d'orange skin appearance. Peripheral eosinophilia and elevated inflammatory markers are typical.

#### **Synonyms:**

Shulmans Syndrome (Eosinophilic Fasciitis)

### **Eosinophilic Gastroenteritis**

Rare chronic inflammatory condition characterized by eosinophilic infiltration of the gastrointestinal tract beyond the esophagus involving any segment from stomach to rectum and extending beyond the mucosa to involve the muscularis propria or serosa.

### **Eosinophilic Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis**

EGPA (formerly Churg-Strauss syndrome): an ANCA-associated vasculitis characterized by asthma, peripheral and tissue eosinophilia, and necrotizing vasculitis.

### **Ependymoma**

A glioma arising from the ependymal cells lining the ventricles and spinal canal; more common in children and frequently associated with hydrocephalus.

### **Epicardium**

The outermost layer of the heart wall, which is the visceral layer of the serous pericardium. It consists of a single layer of mesothelial cells and underlying connective tissue containing blood vessels, nerves, and adipose tissue. The epicardium produces pericardial fluid that lubricates the heart surface.

### **Epidemic**

Sudden increase in disease cases above expected level. Examples: cholera outbreak, measles outbreak.

### **Epidemiology**

Study of distribution and determinants of health-related states in populations. Branches: descriptive (who, when, where), analytic (why, how), experimental (intervention trials). Measures: incidence, prevalence, mortality rates, case-fatality rate.

### **Epidermal Inclusion Cyst**

A common benign cyst lined by stratified squamous epithelium with keratin debris. It presents as a firm, mobile, subcutaneous nodule, typically on the face, neck, and back. A central punctum is characteristic. It may become inflamed or infected. Treatment includes complete excision (including the cyst wall) to prevent recurrence.

### **Epidermal Layers**

From deep to superficial, the epidermis consists of the basal, spinous, granular, lucid, and cornified layers. The lucid layer is present mainly in thick skin such as the palms and soles.



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## **Epidermis**

Outermost skin layer, stratified squamous keratinized epithelium approximately 0.1 mm thick, with five layers (superficial to deep): stratum corneum (dead keratinized cells), lucidum (clear layer, thick skin only), granulosum (keratinization begins), spinosum (spiny layer, Langerhans cells), basale (stem cells, melanocytes, Merkel cells).

## **Epidermoid Cyst**

A benign, slow-growing cyst lined by squamous epithelium and filled with keratin, usually presenting as a firm subcutaneous nodule. Rupture can cause inflammation, tenderness, and a foul-smelling discharge.

## **Epidermolysis Bullosa**

A group of genetic disorders causing skin fragility and blistering with minimal trauma. Simplex (intraepidermal blistering), junctional (blistering at lamina lucida), dystrophic (sublamina densa blistering), and Kindler syndrome (mixed). Dystrophic EB can cause scarring, contractures, and squamous cell carcinoma.

## **Epididymal Cyst**

A usually benign, fluid-filled cyst arising in the epididymis. It may be painless and may require treatment only if it causes significant symptoms or complications.

## **Epididymis**

Coiled duct approximately 6 meters long on the posterolateral aspect of each testis, divided into head (caput, receiving efferent tubules from the testis), body (corpus), and tail (cauda, continuing as the vas deferens). Functions include sperm maturation (gaining motility over approximately 12 days), storage (in the tail), and transport.

## **Epididymitis**

Inflammation of the epididymis, commonly caused by infection and presenting with gradual unilateral scrotal pain and swelling. typically resulting from infection. In sexually active men under 35 years, the most common pathogens are sexually transmit-

ted: *Chlamydia trachomatis* (most common) and *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, with epididymitis often accompanied by urethritis.

## **Epidural**

Regional analgesia (or anesthesia) delivering local anesthetic/opioid via a catheter in the epidural space (lumbar), used for pain relief during labor and for cesarean (higher dose) anesthesia. Provides excellent analgesia while allowing maternal mobility and pushing; reduces catecholamine stress.

## **Epidural Abscess**

A collection of infected material between the dura mater and the skull or vertebral canal, capable of compressing the brain, spinal cord, or nerve roots. Spinal epidural abscess may cause severe focal back pain, fever, neurological deficit, or sphincter dysfunction and requires urgent imaging and specialist assessment.

## **Epidural Analgesia**

Segmental pain relief produced by delivering a local anesthetic, sometimes with an opioid, through a catheter into the epidural space. It may be used during labor or selected operations; the medicines and concentrations depend on the patient and clinical setting.

## **Epidural Analgesia For Labor**

A neuraxial technique for labor analgesia: a catheter is placed in the epidural space (L3-L4 or L2-L3 interspace) and local anesthetic (bupivacaine 0.0625-0.125%) with opioid (fentanyl 2 µg/mL) is infused continuously or in patient-controlled epidural analgesia (PCEA) boluses.

## **Epidural Anesthesia**

A regional anesthetic technique involving injection of local anesthetic and/or opioid into the epidural space (the potential space between the dura mater and the ligamentum flavum within the spinal canal), producing segmental analgesia and sympathetic blockade.

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## Epidural Blood Patch

A minimally invasive procedure used to treat post-dural puncture headache (PDPH) resulting from accidental dural puncture during epidural placement or spinal anesthesia. It involves injecting a small volume of the patient's autologous blood (typically 15-20 mL) into the epidural space at or near the site of the previous puncture.

## Epidural Hematoma

Accumulation of blood between the skull and the dura mater, typically from arterial bleeding (middle meningeal artery) following temporal bone fracture. Presents with loss of consciousness, then a lucid interval (hours), followed by rapid neurological deterioration due to mass effect.

## Epigastric Region

Central superior region between the hypochondriac regions and above the umbilical region. Overlies the stomach, duodenum, pancreas, and portions of the liver. The aorta and inferior vena cava pass through it. Epigastric pain associates with gastric ulcers, pancreatitis, GERD, and aortic aneurysms.

## Epigenetics

Heritable changes in gene expression without DNA sequence alteration. Mechanisms: DNA methylation, histone modification, non-coding RNA. Influenced by environment, diet, stress. Reversible.

## Epiglottitis

A leaf-shaped elastic cartilage at the base of the tongue that covers the laryngeal inlet during swallowing, directing food and liquid into the esophagus and preventing aspiration into the airway. Elevates during swallowing (with the larynx) under glossopharyngeal/vagal innervation.

## Epiglottitis

Epiglottitis is potentially life-threatening inflammation and swelling around the epiglottis that can rapidly obstruct the airway, especially in children. Haemophilus influenzae type b (now rare due to vaccination). Presents with high fever, drooling, dysphagia, tripod position, and rapid progression

to airway obstruction. Do not examine the throat.

## Epilepsy

Epilepsy is a disorder of recurrent unprovoked seizures caused by abnormal brain electrical activity; classification guides medication, safety counseling, and other treatment. electrical activity in the brain. Classification includes focal, generalized, and unknown onset seizures. Etiology: genetic, structural, metabolic, infectious, immune. Diagnosis: clinical history, EEG, neuroimaging.

### Synonyms:

Seizure Disorder

## Epilepsy Surgery

Indicated for patients with drug-resistant epilepsy who have a concordant, resectable seizure focus identified on comprehensive presurgical evaluation. Failure of two or more appropriately chosen and adequately dosed antiepileptic drugs to achieve sustained seizure freedom.

## Epinephrin (Adrenaline)

An alternate spelling of epinephrine, a catecholamine hormone and medicine that increases heart rate and airway diameter and constricts blood vessels.

### Synonyms:

Adrenaline

## Epinephrine (Adrenaline)

A catecholamine hormone and neurotransmitter produced by the adrenal medulla and sympathetic nerve terminals, acting on alpha-1, alpha-2, beta-1, beta-2, and beta-3 adrenergic receptors.

### Synonyms:

Adrenaline

## Epiphora

Excessive tearing caused by impaired tear drainage or reflex hypersecretion. Causes: nasolacrimal duct obstruction (most common in infants and elderly), punctal stenosis, eyelid malposition (ectropion, entropion), and reflex tearing from dry eye or ocular surface irritation.

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## Epiphyseal Plate

A layer of hyaline cartilage, also called the growth plate or physis, located between the epiphysis and metaphysis of a growing long bone. It permits longitudinal bone growth through endochondral ossification, progressing from resting cartilage through proliferation and hypertrophy to calcification and replacement by bone.

### Synonyms:

the growth plate or physis, located between.

## Epiphysis

The expanded end of a long bone, usually covered by articular cartilage where it forms a synovial joint. It contains spongy (trabecular) bone with a thin outer shell of compact bone and contributes to the shape and function of the joint.

## Episcleritis

Usually self-limited inflammation of the thin tissue overlying the white of the eye, causing localized redness and mild discomfort. connective tissue between the sclera and conjunctiva.

## Episiotomy

A clinical condition or finding involving episiotomy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Episiotomy Repair

Surgical repair of an episiotomy incision after delivery. Technique: continuous suturing of the vaginal mucosa (2-0 chromic), interrupted sutures for the perineal muscles, and subcuticular closure of the perineal skin. The rectum should be examined after repair (suture inadvertently through the rectal mucosa).

## Epispadias

A congenital defect in which the urethral opening is on the upper surface of the penis or in an abnormal position in females, often associated with bladder-exstrophy spectrum.

## Epistasis

Interaction between genes where one gene masks or modifies expression of another. Examples: coat color in mice, ABO blood group modifications.

## Epistaxis

Bleeding from the nasal mucosa that may range from minor bleeding to a medical emergency. See Nosebleed.

## Epithelial Tissue

The tissue that covers external body surfaces, lines internal cavities and pathways, and forms glands.

## Epithelium

Sheets of closely packed cells covering body surfaces, lining cavities and ducts, or forming glands; epithelial injury, dysplasia, and carcinoma are important clinical concepts. body (skin, mucous membranes, serous membranes) and form glands.

## Epley Maneuver

A sequence of head and body movements used to move displaced otoconia from the posterior semicircular canal into the utricle. It is commonly used to treat posterior-canal benign paroxysmal positional vertigo.

## Epstein Pearls

Small, white keratin-filled cysts on the palate of a newborn that usually disappear without treatment.

## Epstein-Barr Virus

EBV (human herpesvirus 4): ubiquitous virus causing infectious mononucleosis, transmitted via saliva ('kissing disease').

## Erb's Palsy

Upper brachial plexus injury (C5-C6) causing weakness or paralysis of the shoulder and arm muscles. Presents with the characteristic waiter's tip position: arm adducted, elbow extended, forearm pronated, wrist flexed. Most commonly caused by shoulder dystocia during delivery. See also Brachial Plexus Injury.

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### **Erdheim–Chester Disease**

A rare, non-Langerhans cell histiocytosis characterized by xanthogranulomatous infiltration of multiple organ systems, most commonly the long bones, retroperitoneum, and cardiovascular system. It causes symmetric osteosclerosis of the diaphyses and metaphyses of long bones, exophthalmos, and xanthelasma.

### **Erectile Disorder**

A sexual dysfunction characterized by persistent or recurrent difficulty achieving or maintaining an erection sufficient for sexual activity, or a marked decrease in erectile rigidity, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing marked distress. Prevalence: 10-20% of men under 60, rising to 40-70% over age 70.

### **Erectile Dysfunction**

The persistent inability to achieve or maintain an erection sufficient for satisfactory sexual performance. Affects up to 50% of men aged 40-70. Etiology: organic (vascular disease, diabetes, hypogonadism, neurological disorders, medications, Peyronie disease) and psychogenic (anxiety, depression, relationship issues).

### **Ergonomics**

The design of tasks, tools, and environments to fit human capabilities and reduce discomfort, error, and injury.

### **Ergotism**

A toxidrome caused by prolonged exposure to ergot alkaloids from the fungus *Claviceps purpurea* contaminating rye and other grains, or from ergot-derived medications.

### **Erosion**

A superficial loss of skin or mucosal epithelium that does not extend through the full thickness of the tissue, caused by friction, inflammation, infection, trauma, or chemical injury.

### **Erosion (Tooth)**

Chemical wear without bacterial involvement. Causes: acidic foods/drinks, gastric acid (GERD,

bulimia), environmental acids. Management: dietary modification, fluoride, restoration.

### **Synonyms:**

Tooth

### **Erosive Gastritis**

Inflammation of the stomach lining with superficial erosions but no full-thickness ulceration. Commonly caused by NSAIDs, alcohol, or critical illness. May present with epigastric pain or gastrointestinal bleeding. Diagnosis is by upper endoscopy showing erosions and erythema.

### **Eruption Cyst**

A fluid-filled swelling over a tooth that is about to erupt, often appearing blue or purple and usually resolving when the tooth emerges.

### **Eruptive Xanthomas**

Sudden eruption of numerous small, yellow-orange papules with an erythematous halo, typically on the buttocks, elbows, knees, and trunk, caused by severe hypertriglyceridemia. They represent lipid-laden macrophages in the dermis and are a marker of significantly elevated serum triglycerides, often exceeding 1000 mg/dL.

### **Erysipelas**

An acute superficial bacterial skin infection, usually caused by beta-haemolytic streptococci, producing a sharply demarcated, raised, tender, bright-red plaque with fever.

### **Erythema**

Redness of the skin or mucous membranes caused by increased blood flow to dilated superficial capillaries, often associated with inflammation, infection, or another underlying condition. It commonly blanches with pressure, unlike purpura.

### **Erythema Ab Igne**

A reticulated, hyperpigmented erythematous patch caused by chronic, repeated exposure to moderate heat or infrared radiation, such as from heating pads, laptops, or fireplaces. Histologically it shows increased melanin and dermal amyloid deposition.

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### Erythema Gyrratum Repens

A distinctive, rapidly moving, concentric erythematous eruption with a wood-grain or serpiginous pattern. It is often associated with an underlying malignancy, especially lung cancer, and should prompt an appropriate evaluation while other causes are considered.

### Erythema Infectiosum

A common childhood exanthem caused by parvovirus B19, also called fifth disease. A mild prodrome is followed by a slapped-cheek facial eruption and a lacy rash on the trunk and limbs.

**Synonyms:**  
fifth disease.

### Erythema Marginatum

A migratory, non-pruritic, erythematous rash with a serpiginous or annular pattern that blanches centrally, occurring as a major Jones criterion in acute rheumatic fever. It typically appears on the trunk and proximal extremities and may come and go over days or weeks.

### Erythema Migrans

The expanding annular skin lesion of early Lyme disease, appearing days to weeks after infection with *Borrelia* transmitted by Ixodes ticks. It may be uniformly erythematous rather than a classic bull's-eye lesion and is usually diagnosed clinically.

### Erythema Multiforme

An acute, self-limited immune-mediated reaction, most commonly triggered by herpes simplex virus (90 percent of cases) and *Mycoplasma pneumoniae*. It presents as target lesions (iris lesions with three zones: central dusky, middle pale edematous ring, outer erythematous halo) on extremities.

### Erythema Nodosum

The most common form of panniculitis, characterized by painful, erythematous, tender nodules and plaques on the bilateral shins, representing an inflammatory reaction of the subcutaneous fat.

### Erythrasma

A superficial skin infection caused by *Corynebacterium minutissimum*, producing sharply demarcated reddish-brown patches in skin folds that fluoresce coral-red under Wood lamp.

### Erythrocyte

A mature red blood cell specialized to transport oxygen and carbon dioxide through the circulation. Its biconcave, anucleate form maximizes surface area and flexibility; haemoglobin provides the principal oxygen-binding capacity.

### Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate

A non-specific inflammatory marker measuring the rate at which erythrocytes settle in 1 hour. Normals: males age/2, females (age+10)/2. Markedly elevated >100 mm/hr: suggests infection (endocarditis), autoimmune (giant cell arteritis, polymyalgia rheumatica, SLE, RA), malignancy (multiple myeloma), and chronic kidney disease.

### Erythrocytosis

An increased red-cell mass, usually reflected by elevated haemoglobin and haematocrit. It may be relative because of reduced plasma volume or absolute because of increased erythropoiesis, which can be primary from a marrow disorder or secondary to hypoxia, erythropoietin production, or other causes.

### Erythrodermic Psoriasis

A severe, life-threatening variant of psoriasis characterised by widespread erythema and scaling involving more than 90% of the body surface area, often with systemic symptoms including fever, chills, and hemodynamic instability.

### Erythromelalgia

Episodic burning pain, redness, and warmth of the extremities triggered by warmth or exercise and relieved by cooling, caused by arteriolar inflammation and platelet-mediated microvascular occlusion.

### Erythromycin Ophthalmic Prophylaxis

Application of ophthalmic erythromycin to a newborn soon after birth to reduce the risk of gonococcal



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ophthalmia neonatorum. Use, timing, and alternatives depend on local policy, availability, and the mother's infection-risk assessment.

### **Erythroplakia**

A persistent red patch of mucosa, especially in the mouth, that may represent a premalignant or malignant lesion and requires clinical evaluation, often including biopsy.

### **Erythropoiesis**

The process by which haematopoietic stem and progenitor cells develop into mature red blood cells. It occurs primarily in adult bone marrow and is regulated chiefly by erythropoietin in response to tissue oxygenation; maturation requires iron, vitamin B12, folate, and appropriate marrow function.

### **Erythropoiesis-Stimulating Agents**

Medicines such as epoetin alfa and darbepoetin alfa that stimulate red-cell production, often used for selected forms of anemia in chronic kidney disease or cancer treatment. Use requires appropriate assessment of iron status, risks, and treatment targets.

### **Erythropoietin**

A glycoprotein hormone (EPO) that regulates erythropoiesis—the production of red blood cells in the bone marrow. Produced primarily by interstitial peritubular cells in the kidney ( 90%) and hepatocytes ( 10%) in response to tissue hypoxia.

### **ESBL**

Extended-spectrum beta-lactamase, enzymes that hydrolyse penicillins, cephalosporins, and monobactams. ESBLs are common in Enterobacteriaceae, particularly *Klebsiella pneumoniae* and *E. coli*. ESBL production confers resistance to most beta-lactam antibiotics except carbapenems.

### **ESBL-Producing Organisms**

Bacteria that produce extended-spectrum beta-lactamases (ESBLs), enzymes that hydrolyze penicillins, cephalosporins, and monobactams. ESBLs are common in Enterobacteriaceae, particularly *Klebsiella pneumoniae* and *E. coli*. ESBL produc-

tion confers resistance to most beta-lactam antibiotics except carbapenems.

### **Escherichia Coli**

A gram-negative bacterium that normally lives in the intestine but can cause urinary, intestinal, bloodstream, and other infections. Different strains produce different clinical syndromes, including traveler's diarrhea, bloody diarrhea, and hemolytic uremic syndrome.

### **Escherichia Coli O157:H7 Infection**

Infection with a Shiga-toxin-producing strain of *E. coli*, usually acquired from contaminated food, water, or contact with infected animals or people. It commonly causes severe abdominal cramps and bloody diarrhea and can lead to hemolytic uremic syndrome, especially in children. Medical advice is important; antibiotics and antidiarrheal medicines may be inappropriate in suspected cases.

### **ESKD**

End-stage kidney disease defined as GFR less than 15 or need for dialysis. Medicare eligibility at GFR less than 15 or on dialysis. Palliative care option for those not wanting renal replacement therapy. Comprehensive advance care planning essential.

### **Esophageal Achalasia**

Primary esophageal motility disorder characterized by failure of the lower esophageal sphincter to relax during swallowing and absent peristalsis in the distal esophagus, resulting from selective loss of inhibitory neurons in the myenteric plexus.

### **Esophageal Atresia**

A congenital anomaly where the esophagus ends in a blind pouch, often with a tracheoesophageal fistula connecting the distal esophagus to the trachea. Presents with drooling, inability to pass a nasogastric tube, and choking with feedings. The 3 Es association: Esophageal atresia, Esophageal anomalies, and Extremity anomalies.

### **Esophageal Cancer**

Malignant tumor of the esophagus. Squamous



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cell carcinoma predominates in the upper and middle third (smoking, alcohol); adenocarcinoma of the lower third arises from Barrett esophagus. Presents with progressive dysphagia and weight loss; treatment depends on stage and includes surgery, chemoradiation, and systemic therapy.

**Synonyms:**

Cancer, Esophageal

### **Esophageal Candidiasis**

Fungal infection of the esophagus caused by *Candida* species common in immunocompromised patients including those with HIV, organ transplant recipients, and patients on inhaled corticosteroids. Presents with odynophagia and dysphagia. Diagnosed by endoscopy showing white adherent plaques and biopsy confirming fungal hyphae.

### **Esophageal Dilation**

Endoscopic passage of bougies or balloons to widen esophageal strictures. Used for symptomatic strictures from peptic disease, radiation, caustic injury, or eosinophilic esophagitis. Savary bougies are passed over a guidewire with progressive dilation. Through-the-scope balloons allow controlled radial dilation under direct visualization.

### **Esophageal Diverticulum**

Outpouching of the esophageal wall classified by location. Zenker diverticulum occurs in the hypopharynx and is the most common esophageal diverticulum. Mid-esophageal diverticula are traction diverticula caused by extrinsic inflammatory disease including tuberculosis and histoplasmosis.

### **Esophageal Foreign Body**

An object or food bolus lodged in the esophagus, causing difficulty swallowing, pain, drooling, or breathing symptoms. Batteries, sharp objects, complete obstruction, and perforation require urgent assessment and removal.

### **Esophageal Intramural Pseudodiverticulosis**

Condition characterized by multiple small outpouchings of the esophageal submucosal glands seen on

barium swallow as flask-shaped contrast collections oriented longitudinally along the esophagus. The pseudodiverticula are not true diverticula but rather dilated excretory ducts of submucosal glands.

### **Esophageal Leukoplakia**

White plaques on the esophageal mucosa representing squamous cell hyperplasia with hyperkeratosis. Similar to oral leukoplakia it is considered a potentially premalignant condition. Associated with chronic irritation from smoking, alcohol, and gastroesophageal reflux.

### **Esophageal Manometry**

Diagnostic test measuring esophageal motor function by recording intraluminal pressures during swallowing. A catheter with pressure sensors is passed through the nose into the stomach and withdrawn to record pressures at multiple levels. High-resolution manometry using closely spaced sensors provides a spatiotemporal color plot.

### **Esophageal Perforation**

Full-thickness rupture of the esophageal wall, most commonly Boerhaave syndrome from forceful vomiting occurring on the left posterolateral distal esophagus. Iatrogenic perforation during endoscopy is another common cause. Presents with chest pain, subcutaneous emphysema, and mediastinitis.

### **Esophageal PH Monitoring**

24-hour ambulatory monitoring of esophageal acid exposure. Catheter-based (transnasal pH probe placed 5 cm above LES) or wireless (Bravo capsule endoscopically attached to esophageal mucosa). Measures: % time pH <4 (total, upright, supine), DeMeester score (>14.7 abnormal), and symptom-reflux correlation.

### **Esophageal Spasm**

Esophageal motility disorder characterized by uncoordinated or excessive contractions impairing bolus transport. Diffuse esophageal spasm shows simultaneous contractions on manometry. Jackhammer esophagus features extremely high-amplitude peristaltic contractions.

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## Esophageal Stent

Self-expanding metal stent for esophageal obstruction. Palliative for malignancy. Migration, tumor ingrowth common complications.

## Esophageal Stricture

Narrowing of the esophageal lumen from chronic gastroesophageal reflux disease, caustic ingestion, or eosinophilic esophagitis. Presents with progressive dysphagia initially to solids then liquids. Diagnosed by upper endoscopy and barium swallow.

## Esophageal Surgery

Operations on the esophagus or its junction with the stomach, including procedures for reflux, stricture, cancer, perforation, or motility disorders. The operation is selected according to the disease, anatomy, symptoms, and surgical risk.

## Esophageal Varices

Dilated, tortuous submucosal veins in the lower esophagus, most commonly caused by portal hypertension (cirrhosis—hepatic fibrosis with increased portal venous pressure >10 mmHg). They develop as portosystemic collaterals connecting the portal venous system (left gastric vein) to the systemic venous system (azygos vein).

### Synonyms:

Varices, Esophageal

## Esophageal Web

Thin mucosal fold protruding into the esophageal lumen most commonly in the postcricoid region or upper esophagus. Webs may be asymptomatic or cause dysphagia particularly to solids. Multiple webs can occur in association with iron deficiency anemia as part of Plummer-Vinson syndrome or Paterson-Kelly syndrome.

## Esophagitis

Esophagitis is inflammation or injury of the esophageal lining caused by reflux, infection, medication, allergy, radiation, or other mechanisms.

## Esophagogastric Bypass

Surgical creation of a conduit between the esophagus and stomach to restore gastrointestinal continuity, most commonly performed as part of esophagectomy or to palliate unresectable esophageal malignancy. Techniques include gastric pull-up with esophagogastrostomy and jejunal interposition.

## Esophagogastroduodenoscopy

Upper endoscopy: flexible endoscopic examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum.

## Esophagus

A muscular tube that transports food and liquids from the pharynx (throat) to the stomach.

## Esophagus (Esophagus)

A muscular tube approximately 25 cm long connecting the pharynx to the stomach, extending from the cricopharyngeus muscle (at the level of C6) to the gastroesophageal junction (T11).

### Synonyms:

esophagus

## Esotropia

A type of strabismus in which one eye deviates inward (toward the nose). Congenital/infantile esotropia: large-angle, constant, onset before 6 months; requires early surgical correction. Accommodative esotropia: associated with hyperopia, onset age 2-3 years; treatment with corrective glasses improves alignment.

## ESR

The erythrocyte sedimentation rate, a nonspecific blood test measuring how quickly red cells settle in a tube; it can reflect inflammation but cannot identify its cause.

## Essential Hypertension

Persistent elevation of systemic arterial blood pressure without an identifiable single secondary cause. It results from interacting genetic, vascular, renal, metabolic, and environmental factors and increases the risk of stroke, coronary disease, heart failure,

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kidney disease, and retinopathy.

### **Essential Medicines**

Drugs that satisfy the priority healthcare needs of a population, as defined by the WHO Model List of Essential Medicines. Selection criteria include efficacy, safety, comparative cost-effectiveness, and suitability for use in resource-limited settings.

### **Essential Mixed Cryoglobulinemia**

A disorder in which circulating immunoglobulins precipitate in cooler temperatures and deposit in small blood vessels, causing vasculitis. Symptoms may include purpura, joint pain, weakness, nerve problems, kidney disease, and cold sensitivity. Evaluation includes cryoglobulin testing and assessment for infections, autoimmune disease, and lymphoproliferative disorders.

### **Essential Nutrient**

Nutrient that cannot be synthesized by body, must be obtained from diet. Essential amino acids, fatty acids, vitamins, minerals.

### **Essential Thrombocythemia**

A chronic myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by sustained platelet count elevation (greater than 450,000 per microliter) due to clonal megakaryocytic proliferation, with a risk of both thrombotic and hemorrhagic complications.

### **Essential Tremor**

The most common movement disorder, characterized by a bilateral, symmetrical, postural and kinetic tremor predominantly affecting the upper extremities, with a frequency of four to twelve hertz. It typically begins insidiously in the second or third decade of life and slowly progresses over years.

### **Estimated Due Date**

The expected date of delivery, calculated as 40 weeks (280 days) from the first day of the last menstrual period. Confirmed or adjusted by first-trimester ultrasound crown-rump length measurement (most accurate  $\pm 5$ -7 days). Second-trimester ultrasound is less accurate ( $\pm 10$ -14 days). Third-trimester is

least accurate ( $\pm 21$ -30 days).

### **Estimated Fetal Weight**

An ultrasound-derived estimate of fetal weight, calculated using formulas that combine BPD, HC, AC, and FL. The Hadlock formula (using HC, AC, FL) is the most commonly used. Accuracy:  $\pm 10$ -15%. Indications: assess fetal growth, determine size for gestational age, and plan delivery. EFW <10th percentile: SGA/IUGR.

### **Estimated Glomerular Filtration Rate**

An estimate of glomerular filtration derived from serum creatinine and, depending on the validated equation, age and sex. It is used to stage chronic kidney disease and guide medication dosing, but is less reliable when creatinine is changing rapidly or in unusual body composition.

### **Estrogen**

A group of steroid hormones involved in reproductive development, menstrual regulation, bone health, and other physiologic functions.

### **Ethmoid Bone**

Delicate bone between the orbits forming parts of the nasal septum and orbital/nasal roofs. Has the cribriform plate (olfactory nerve filaments), perpendicular plate (superior nasal septum), and labyrinths (nasal conchae, ethmoid air cells). The crista galli provides falx cerebri attachment.

### **Ethmoidal Air Cells**

Air-filled spaces in the ethmoid bone that form part of the paranasal sinus system.

### **Ethmoidal Sinus**

The ethmoidal sinuses, also known as ethmoidal air cells, are a collection of multiple small, thin-walled, air-containing cavities within the ethmoid bone between the orbits and above the nasal cavity, and they are divided into anterior and posterior groups based on their drainage sites.

#### **Synonyms:**

ethmoidal air cells, are a collection of multiple.

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## Ethylene Glycol

A toxic alcohol found in some antifreeze and industrial products. Ingestion can cause severe metabolic acidosis, neurologic impairment, kidney injury, and death.

## Ethylene Glycol Poisoning

Toxicity from ingestion of ethylene glycol, often found in antifreeze. Its metabolites can cause severe metabolic acidosis, neurologic impairment, kidney injury, and calcium-oxalate deposition. It requires urgent toxicology assessment and antidotal or extracorporeal treatment when indicated.

## Etiology

The cause or set of causes of a disease or health condition, including genetic, infectious, environmental, immune, traumatic, and behavioural factors.

## Euphoria

An intense feeling of well-being, elation, or happiness, which can be a normal emotional response or a pathologic symptom.

## Eustachian Tube

Auditory/pharyngotympanic tube connecting the middle ear to the nasopharynx, approximately 36 mm long in adults. Cartilaginous medial two-thirds and bony lateral third. Functions: equalizing middle ear/atmospheric pressure, draining middle ear secretions, and protecting from nasopharyngeal pathogens.

## Eustachian-Tube Dysfunction

Failure of the auditory tube to equalize middle-ear pressure or clear secretions. It can cause aural fullness, popping, conductive hearing loss, and retracted tympanic membrane and is common with upper-respiratory infection, allergic rhinitis, or craniofacial disorders.

## Euthanasia

The deliberate act of ending a person's life to relieve suffering, typically performed by a physician. Active euthanasia involves directly administering a lethal substance (e.g., barbiturate overdose followed by

neuromuscular blockade) at the patient's explicit request.

## Euthanasia And Assisted Dying

Ethical and legal concepts regarding intentional termination of life to relieve intractable pain and suffering. Active Euthanasia: deliberate administration of a lethal agent (e.g., lethal dose of barbiturates) by a physician to terminate a patient's life upon their explicit request.

## Euthyroid Sick Syndrome

Abnormal thyroid function tests in patients with non-thyroidal illness (critical illness, starvation, major surgery) without intrinsic thyroid disease. Pattern: low T3 (most common), low T4, reverse T3 elevated, normal or low TSH. The severity correlates with illness severity.

## Event Monitor

A portable device that records heart rhythm intermittently or when activated during symptoms over an extended period.

## Event-Free Survival

The time from randomization or treatment start to a specified event such as disease progression, relapse, or death from any cause.

## Eversion

Turning the sole of the foot laterally, so that it faces away from the median plane.

## Evidence-Based Medicine

Integration of best research evidence with clinical expertise and patient values. Foundation for clinical guidelines.

## Evidence-Based Practice

Integration of best research evidence, clinical expertise, patient values. Rehabilitation guidelines based on systematic reviews.

## Evisceration

Protrusion of viscera through a dehiscence abdominal

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wound, typically occurring 5-8 days postoperatively and constituting a surgical emergency. Risk factors include obesity, wound infection, and inadequate fascial closure. Management requires sterile coverage, broad-spectrum antibiotics, and emergent operative reclosure.

### **Evoked Potentials (VEP, BAER, SSEP)**

Electrophysiologic tests measuring the CNS electrical response to specific sensory stimuli. Visual evoked potentials (VEP): checkboard pattern reversal, measures P100 latency; delayed in optic neuritis/MS. Brainstem auditory evoked responses (BAER): click stimuli, waves I-V; delayed in acoustic neuroma, MS, brainstem stroke.

#### **Synonyms:**

VEP, BAER, SSEP

### **Ewart Sign**

Dullness to percussion, decreased breath sounds, and bronchial breathing at the left infrascapular region caused by compressive atelectasis from a large pericardial effusion. It is a physical examination finding of pericardial effusion. The effusion compresses the adjacent left lower lobe, creating a zone of consolidation.

### **Ewing Sarcoma**

A highly malignant small round blue cell tumor of bone and soft tissue, representing the second most common primary bone malignancy in children and adolescents (peak age 10-20 years), with a strong predilection for males and Caucasian populations.

### **Exacerbation Of COPD**

An acute worsening of respiratory symptoms beyond normal day-to-day variations, requiring change in medication. It is commonly triggered by respiratory infections (viral, bacterial), air pollution, or non-compliance. Treatment includes increased bronchodilators, systemic corticosteroids, antibiotics if indicated, and oxygen therapy.

### **Examination**

Systematic assessment of a patient's health status. Components: inspection, palpation, percussion, aus-

cultation (IPPA). General survey: appearance, posture, gait, vital signs. Focused examination based on chief complaint.

### **Exanthema**

A widespread skin eruption, usually macular or papular, associated with an acute systemic illness. Viral infections are common causes, but drug reactions, bacterial disease, immune disorders, and other systemic conditions may also produce exanthema; fever, mucosal involvement, blistering, or skin pain may indicate a severe process.

### **Exanthematous Pustulosis**

An acute drug-related skin eruption with numerous small, sterile, non-follicular pustules on reddened skin. Fever and neutrophilia may occur. It often improves after the causative medicine is withdrawn, but severe cases require medical assessment.

### **Exchange Transfusion**

Emergent procedure to rapidly lower severe hyperbilirubinemia by removing small volumes of the infant's blood and replacing with compatible donor blood. Used when phototherapy fails or bilirubin approaches toxic levels (greater than 25 mg/dL in term infants or above exchange threshold on Bhutani curve).

### **Excision**

The surgical removal of a piece of tissue, an organ, or a lesion. Excisional biopsy removes the entire lesion with a margin of normal tissue, used for definitive diagnosis and treatment of small tumors (suspected melanoma, breast lump, lymph node).

### **Excisional Biopsy**

Surgical removal of entire lesion. Diagnosis and treatment.

### **Excitation-Contraction Coupling**

The sequence of events linking an action potential to muscle contraction. In skeletal muscle: the action potential travels down the T-tubule, triggering calcium release from the sarcoplasmic reticulum via ryanodine receptors (calcium-induced calcium



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release mediated by voltage-gated dihydropyridine receptors).

### **Excoriation Disorder**

Recurrent skin picking resulting in skin lesions. The individual has made repeated attempts to decrease or stop the skin picking. The skin picking causes clinically significant distress or impairment. It is not attributable to a medical condition or substance. Common sites include face, arms, and hands.

### **Excretion**

Removal of substance from body. Routes: renal (urine), hepatic (bile), pulmonary (gas), sweat, breast milk. Important for toxicity and drug clearance.

### **Exercise Intolerance**

Reduced ability to perform physical activity at the expected level because of exertional fatigue, breathlessness, chest discomfort, leg pain, or other symptoms. Causes include cardiac, pulmonary, vascular, metabolic, neuromuscular, haematological, and deconditioning states.

### **Exercise Stress Test**

A noninvasive cardiac diagnostic test that evaluates the cardiovascular response to graded physical exertion, primarily used to diagnose coronary artery disease, assess functional capacity, and guide prognosis.

### **Exercise-Induced Arrhythmias**

Catecholamine-sensitive ventricular tachycardia and right ventricular outflow tract VT can be triggered by exercise. HCM-related sudden death risk increases during vigorous exercise. Exercise-induced myocardial ischemia may trigger ventricular arrhythmias in CAD.

### **Exercise-Induced Asthma**

Bronchoconstriction occurring during or shortly after physical exertion, causing cough, wheezing, chest tightness, or shortness of breath. It is associated with airway hyperresponsiveness and may occur in people with or without persistent asthma.

### **Exercise-Induced Bronchoconstriction**

Airway narrowing during or after exercise, presenting with cough, wheeze, and dyspnea. It occurs in up to 90% of asthmatics and is triggered by heat and water loss from the airways. Prevention includes pre-exercise SABA.

### **Exhaled Nitric Oxide**

A non-invasive measure of airway eosinophilic inflammation. FeNO > 25 ppb in adults suggests eosinophilic airway inflammation and predicts response to inhaled corticosteroids. It is useful for diagnosing eosinophilic asthma, monitoring treatment response, and differentiating asthma from other causes of cough.

### **Exhibitionistic Disorder**

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent, intense sexual arousal from exposing one's genitals to an unsuspecting person. The individual has acted on these urges or they cause marked distress or interpersonal difficulty. Duration  $\geq 6$  months. Onset typically before age 18. Treatment: CBT and SSRIs.

### **Exhumation**

The lawful disinterment and removal of a buried body or remains for re-examination, re-testing, or identification. Indications: new evidence, suspicion of poisoning or foul play, DNA testing, paternity/maternity testing, exhumation of a wrongly buried body, or repatriation.

### **Existential Distress**

Emotional suffering related to questions of meaning, identity, freedom, mortality, or purpose, often occurring during serious illness.

### **Exit Wound**

A skin defect produced where a projectile leaves the body, typically larger, irregular, and stellate, with everted edges, no abrasion ring or soot. Size depends on deformation, yaw, and fragmentation; small non-deformed bullets may produce shored exits, and an exit may be absent if the projectile is retained.



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## Exocytosis

Process by which intracellular vesicles fuse with the plasma membrane, releasing their contents into the extracellular space and incorporating membrane proteins/lipids into the cell membrane. The SNARE complex (v-SNARE on vesicles and t-SNARE on target membrane) mediates vesicle docking and fusion.

## Exon

A segment of a DNA or RNA molecule containing information coding for a protein or peptide sequence.

## Exophthalmos

Abnormal protrusion of the eyeball (globe) from the orbit, most commonly caused by thyroid eye disease (Graves ophthalmopathy—an autoimmune condition associated with hyperthyroidism). The proptosis results from inflammation, edema, and fibrosis of the extraocular muscles and proliferation of orbital fat within the fixed bony orbit.

## Exotropia

A type of strabismus in which one eye deviates outward (toward the temple). Intermittent exotropia: most common type, often noticed when tired or daydreaming, can be controlled with fusion. Constant exotropia: requires treatment to prevent amblyopia. Congenital exotropia: rare, requires early evaluation.

## Expectorants

Medications that promote the clearance of mucus from the respiratory tract by increasing sputum volume and reducing its viscosity, facilitating productive cough. The most common expectorant is guaifenesin (glyceryl guaiacolate), which increases respiratory tract fluid secretion and reduces sputum adhesiveness.

## Expectoration

The act of coughing up and spitting out mucus, sputum, or phlegm from the respiratory tract; sputum production.

## Expiratory Grunting

A forced exhalation against a partially closed glottis, creating an audible sound. It is an end-expiratory maneuver that generates intrinsic PEEP, helping to maintain alveolar recruitment and improve oxygenation. It is commonly seen in children with respiratory distress.

## Explantation

Surgical removal of an implanted device or prosthesis. It may be required for infection, malfunction, intolerance, migration, fracture, tissue injury, or completion of a temporary therapy.

## Exploratory Laparotomy

Open surgical entry into the abdominal cavity to diagnose or treat suspected intra-abdominal pathology, such as hemorrhage, perforation, ischemia, or obstruction, when less invasive evaluation is inadequate or inappropriate.

## Exposure Route

Path by which substance enters body. Routes: inhalation, ingestion, dermal, injection, ocular. Determines absorption rate and toxicity.

## Expressivity

Degree to which a genotype is expressed in phenotype. Variable expressivity: same genotype produces different phenotypic severity in different individuals. Examples: neurofibromatosis type 1, Marfan syndrome.

## Extension

Movement that increases the angle between two bones or straightens a joint.

## Extensively Drug-Resistant TB

TB resistant to isoniazid, rifampin, fluoroquinolones, and at least one injectable agent. Very limited treatment options and poor outcomes.

## Extensor Digitorum

Posterior forearm muscle from lateral epicondyle via the common extensor tendon, dividing into 4 ten-

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dons inserting on extensor expansions of digits 2-5. Innervated by posterior interosseous nerve (C7-C8). Extends MCP joints, assists PIP/DIP extension. Lateral epicondylitis (tennis elbow) is an overuse injury of its common origin.

### **External Auditory Canal**

Tube from the concha to the tympanic membrane, approximately 2.5 cm long in adults. Lateral third is cartilaginous; medial two-thirds are bony (temporal bone). Skin-lined with ceruminous glands (producing cerumen/earwax) and hair follicles. Cerumen has antimicrobial and insect-repellent properties.

### **External Beam Radiation Therapy**

Radiation delivered from a machine outside the body to a planned treatment area. Techniques include three-dimensional conformal therapy, intensity-modulated therapy, and stereotactic therapy.

### **External Cephalic Version**

A procedure that uses external pressure to turn a breech or transverse fetus into a head-down position. Timing, eligibility, monitoring, and contraindications depend on gestational age, placental and fetal factors, and the clinical setting.

### **External Fixation**

Stabilization of a fracture or limb using pins or wires attached to an external frame. It may provide temporary damage-control stabilization or definitive treatment, particularly when soft-tissue injury or contamination limits internal fixation.

### **External Iliac Artery**

Larger common iliac terminal branch, continuing as the femoral artery below the inguinal ligament. Gives off inferior epigastric and deep circumflex iliac arteries. Related to external iliac vein medially and ureter anteriorly. Commonly used for cardiac catheterization and endovascular access.

### **External Jugular Vein**

Formed by posterior auricular and retromandibular vein divisions, crossing the sternocleidomastoid superficially to drain into the subclavian vein. Visi-

ble through the skin; used for peripheral IV access when other sites are unavailable. Distended in right heart failure and SVC obstruction. A useful physical examination landmark.

### **External Oblique Muscle**

Most superficial flat abdominal muscle from outer lower eight ribs to linea alba, pubic tubercle, and iliac crest. Innervated by T7-T12. Contralateral trunk rotation and flexion; compresses abdomen. Forms the inguinal ligament from its free inferior border. Superficial inguinal ring is an opening in its aponeurosis.

### **External Resorption**

Loss of tooth structure from outside. Inflammatory, replacement, surface, cervical resorption. Treatment depends on type and extent.

### **Extracellular Fluid**

The fluid outside cells, including plasma and interstitial fluid. Sodium, chloride, and bicarbonate are its principal effective solutes; ECF volume and composition are regulated by the kidneys, cardiovascular system, and endocrine mechanisms.

### **Extracellular Matrix**

A complex network of proteins and carbohydrates secreted by cells that provides structural and chemical support to surrounding cells.

### **Extracellular Pathogens**

Microorganisms that survive and replicate outside host cells. Extracellular bacteria include *Streptococcus*, *Staphylococcus*, and *Escherichia coli*. These pathogens are typically killed by antibodies and complement. They produce toxins and enzymes to damage host tissues.

### **Extracorporeal Membrane Oxygenation**

A temporary mechanical circulatory support system that provides cardiac and/or respiratory support. VA-ECMO (veno-arterial) provides both cardiac and respiratory support; VV-ECMO (veno-venous) provides respiratory support only.

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### **Extracorporeal Shock Wave Lithotripsy**

Non-invasive treatment method for urinary calculi that uses focused acoustic shock waves generated outside the body to fragment kidney or ureteral stones into smaller gravel-like pieces (dust/sand) that pass spontaneously in urine.

### **Extranodal Natural Killer T-Cell Lymphoma**

An aggressive lymphoma arising from natural killer cells, most commonly involving the nasal cavity and upper aerodigestive tract. It is strongly associated with Epstein-Barr virus infection.

### **Extraocular Muscle Function Testing**

Assessment of the six extraocular muscles innervated by CN III (medial rectus: adduction; superior rectus: elevation; inferior rectus: depression; inferior oblique: extorsion), CN IV (superior oblique: intorsion and depression), and CN VI (lateral rectus: abduction).

### **Extraocular Muscles**

Six muscles controlling eye movement: four rectus (superior, inferior, medial, lateral) and two oblique (superior, inferior).

### **Extrapulmonary Manifestation Of Tuberculosis**

Tuberculosis occurring outside the lungs, such as in lymph nodes, bone, kidneys, meninges, or the abdomen.

### **Extrapyramidal Symptoms**

Drug-induced movement disorders caused by D2 receptor blockade in the nigrostriatal pathway.

### **Extrauterine Pregnancy**

A pregnancy in which the fertilized ovum implants outside the uterine cavity, an alternative term for ectopic pregnancy. By far the most common site is the fallopian tube (ampulla 70%, isthmus 12%, fimbria 11%, cornual/interstitial 2–4%).

### **Extravasation**

Leakage of urine outside urinary tract. Causes: trauma, surgery, obstruction. Pseudovesical extravasation (rectus sheath), extraperitoneal, intraperitoneal. Treatment: catheter drainage, surgical repair.

### **Extubate**

Removal of an endotracheal tube after restoration of adequate spontaneous breathing and airway protection.

### **Extubation Criteria**

Clinical findings used to determine whether a patient can safely have an endotracheal tube removed. They include adequate spontaneous breathing, oxygenation, airway protection, cough, neuromuscular recovery, and hemodynamic stability.

### **Exudate**

Protein-rich fluid that escapes from inflamed or injured blood vessels into tissues or body cavities; unlike a transudate, it usually reflects increased vascular permeability.

### **Exudative Pleural Effusion**

From local pleural disease. Causes include pneumonia, malignancy, TB, and PE. Elevated protein, LDH, and cell count.

### **Eye**

The organ of vision, a spherical structure (approximately 24 mm diameter) in the bony orbit. Three layers: fibrous (sclera, cornea), vascular/uveal (choroid, ciliary body, iris), neural (retina). Anterior segment: cornea, anterior chamber (aqueous humor), iris/pupil, lens.

### **Eye Disorders**

The sensory ability to perceive light and interpret visual information processed by the eyes and brain, enabling recognition of shapes, colors, depth, and motion. See Vision.

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## Eye Floaters

Spots, threads, or cobweb-like shapes that move across the visual field, usually caused by opacities in the vitreous. Sudden new floaters, flashes, or a curtain-like shadow require urgent evaluation for retinal tear or detachment. See also Floaters.

## Eye Health

The maintenance of optimal vision and prevention of ocular disease through regular eye examinations, protective measures, and timely treatment. Common conditions affecting eye health include refractive errors, cataracts, glaucoma, diabetic retinopathy, and age-related macular degeneration.

## Eye Irritation

Chemical injury to eye. Immediate irrigation with water or saline for 15-20 minutes. Alkali burns more dangerous than acid. Ophthalmology consultation.

## Eyelid Swelling

Swelling of one or both eyelids caused by allergy, infection, inflammation, trauma, a blocked gland, or angioedema. Pain, fever, impaired eye movement, proptosis, or vision change may indicate an urgent orbital or systemic condition.

## Tearing

Excessive production or inadequate drainage of tears, commonly caused by irritation, allergy, dry-eye reflex tearing, infection, eyelid malposition, or lacrimal-duct obstruction.

## Eye Pain

Pain in or around the eye caused by surface irritation, infection, trauma, inflammation, glaucoma, or orbital disease. Severe pain with vision loss, photophobia, trauma, or nausea requires urgent assessment.

## Eye Redness

Red discoloration of the eye caused by dilation or inflammation of conjunctival or deeper ocular blood vessels. Causes range from irritation and conjunctivitis to keratitis, uveitis, and acute glaucoma.

## Eye Trauma

Ocular injuries ranging from corneal abrasions to globe rupture. Chemical burns: irrigate immediately with saline or water for 30 minutes. Penetrating injuries: shield eye, no pressure, emergent ophthalmology consultation. Foreign bodies: remove superficial items; embedded objects require surgical removal.

## Ectopia Cordis

A rare congenital defect in which the heart is located partly or completely outside the chest.

## Eisenmenger Complex

Severe pulmonary hypertension caused by a long-standing congenital heart defect with abnormal blood flow between the heart chambers or vessels.

## Electroretinography

A clinical condition or finding involving electroretinography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Elliptocytosis

A condition in which many red blood cells have an oval or elliptical shape.

## Encephalomalacia

Softening or loss of brain tissue, usually after an injury, stroke, or infection.

## Encephalomyelitis

Inflammation of the brain and spinal cord.

## Endocardial Fibroelastosis

Abnormal thickening of the inner lining of the heart caused by excess fibrous and elastic tissue, usually in infants or children.

## Endometrial Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of uterine lining for microscopic examination.

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**Endomyocardial Fibrosis**

Scarring and thickening of the inner heart lining and underlying heart muscle that can impair filling.

**Enophthalmos**

Abnormal backward displacement of an eyeball within the eye socket.

**Enterovesical Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the intestine and urinary bladder.

**Eosinophilic Granuloma**

A localized form of Langerhans cell histiocytosis that commonly affects bone or skin.

**Epiretinal Membrane**

A thin layer of scar-like tissue that forms on the surface of the retina and may distort vision.

**Episodic Ataxia**

An inherited disorder causing recurrent brief attacks of impaired coordination and balance.

**Erythroblastosis Fetalis**

Fetal or newborn red-cell destruction caused by maternal antibodies against fetal blood-cell antigens.

**Esophagectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the esophagus.

**Esophagram**

An imaging study of the esophagus performed after the patient swallows a contrast material.

**Euthyroid Goiter**

An enlarged thyroid gland with thyroid-hormone levels that remain within the normal range.

**Evans Syndrome**

An autoimmune disorder in which antibodies destroy red blood cells and platelets, separately or together.

**Evoked Potential**

An electrical response recorded from the nervous system after a specific sensory stimulus.

**Excessive Tearing**

Abnormally increased production or inadequate drainage of tears, causing watery eyes.

**Exfoliative Dermatitis**

Widespread redness, scaling, and shedding of the skin.

**Exsanguination**

Life-threatening loss of blood from severe bleeding.

**Extrahepatic Cholestasis**

Impaired bile flow caused by blockage or disease outside the liver.

**Extrapyramidal Disorder**

A movement disorder caused by dysfunction of brain circuits that regulate posture and involuntary movement.

**Effusion**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in a body space, such as a joint, pleural cavity, or pericardial sac.

**Electrophysiologic Testing**

A procedure that records or provokes electrical activity in the heart to investigate suspected arrhythmias.

**Embolic Stroke**

An ischemic stroke caused by a clot or other material that travels from elsewhere and blocks a brain artery.

**Enteric Nervous System**

The network of nerve cells in the gastrointestinal tract that regulates movement, secretion, and local blood flow.

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## **Epidural Space**

The space outside the dura mater around the spinal cord, where local anesthetic may be injected.

## **External Otitis**

Inflammation or infection of the outer ear canal, commonly called swimmer's ear.

### **Synonyms:**

swimmer's ear.

## **E. Coli Infection**

An infection caused by *Escherichia coli* bacteria, which may cause diarrhea, urinary infection, or more serious illness.

## **Earwax Blockage**

A buildup of earwax that blocks the ear canal and may cause hearing loss, pain, or ringing.

## **Egg Allergy**

An immune reaction to proteins in eggs that may cause skin, digestive, or breathing symptoms.

## **Exercise Headaches**

Headaches triggered by strenuous physical activity.

## **Eye Melanoma**

A cancer that develops in the pigment-producing cells of the eye.

### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Eye Melanoma

## **Eyestrain**

Eye discomfort, fatigue, or blurred vision caused by prolonged visual effort.

## **Electrocautery**

Use of heat produced by an electrical current to cut tissue or control bleeding.

## **Ejaculatory Duct**

A duct formed by the union of the vas deferens and the duct of a seminal vesicle. It passes through the prostate and opens into the urethra.

## **Electronystagmography**

A clinical condition or finding involving electronystagmography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Electrophoresis**

A laboratory method that separates charged molecules according to their movement through a medium in an electric field.

## **Elevator**

A surgical instrument used to lift, separate, or strip tissue, bone, or a tooth from surrounding structures.

## **Emmetropia**

The normal refractive state of the eye, in which parallel light focuses on the retina without accommodation.

## **Endocrine System**

The network of glands and hormone-producing tissues that regulate body functions by releasing hormones into the blood.

## **Endocrine Tissues**

Cells or groups of cells that produce and release hormones into the blood or nearby tissues.

## **Endometrial Ablation**

A procedure that destroys the uterine lining to reduce heavy menstrual bleeding. It is not a method of contraception and is not intended for people planning pregnancy.

## **Enucleation**

Surgical removal of the eyeball while leaving the eyelid, eye muscles, and most orbital tissues in place.

## **Epicondyle**

A bony projection near a condyle that provides attachment for muscles and ligaments.

## **Epigastrium**

The upper middle region of the abdomen, located



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between the right and left hypochondriac regions.

### **Equilibrium Receptors**

Sensory receptors in the vestibular system that detect head position and movement and help maintain balance.

### **Erosive Esophagitis**

Inflammation of the esophagus with visible breaks or erosions in its lining, most commonly caused by gastroesophageal reflux.

### **Escharotomy**

An incision through rigid eschar from a deep circumferential burn to relieve constriction and restore chest expansion or blood flow.

### **Expiration**

The movement of air out of the lungs, usually caused by relaxation of the diaphragm and elastic recoil of the lungs.

### **Excoriation**

A superficial loss of skin caused by scratching, rubbing, or another form of mechanical trauma.

### **Extubation**

Removal of an endotracheal tube after the patient can maintain an open airway and adequate spontaneous breathing.

### **Ependyma**

A specialized epithelial lining of the brain ventricles and spinal-cord central canal that is involved in cerebrospinal-fluid circulation and, in some regions, production.

### **Erythroderma**

Generalized redness and scaling involving most of the skin surface, caused by psoriasis, eczema, drug reactions, lymphoma, or other disease and potentially causing fluid and temperature loss.

### **Eschar**

A firm, usually black or brown layer of dead tissue

over a wound, burn, pressure injury, infection, or vascular lesion that may conceal deeper damage.

### **Eales Disease**

An uncommon retinal vasculopathy characterized by inflammation and obliteration of peripheral retinal veins, often followed by retinal ischemia, neovascularization, and recurrent vitreous hemorrhage.

### **Ecthyma**

A clinical condition or finding involving ecthyma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Efferent Neuron**

A nerve cell that carries motor or autonomic signals away from the central nervous system to muscles, glands, or other target tissues.

### **Erdheim-Chester Disease**

A rare non-Langerhans-cell histiocytosis caused by clonal histiocyte proliferation, commonly producing symmetrical long-bone pain or sclerosis and possible cardiovascular, renal, neurologic, or retroperitoneal involvement.

### **Edentulousness**

Complete or partial absence of natural teeth. It may result from dental disease, trauma, developmental abnormalities, or tooth extraction and can impair chewing, speech, and oral function.

### **Eustachian Tube Dysfunction**

Failure of the eustachian tube to open or close normally, causing ear pressure, muffled hearing, pain, or recurrent middle-ear fluid. It may follow an upper-respiratory infection, allergy, or rapid pressure changes.

### **Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency**

Inadequate secretion of pancreatic digestive enzymes, causing maldigestion and malabsorption, often with weight loss, bloating, and greasy or difficult-to-flush stools. Common causes include chronic pancreatitis, cystic fibrosis, and pancreatic

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surgery.

### **Ectasia**

Abnormal widening or dilation of a tubular structure, vessel, duct, or organ. The term is used in conditions such as vascular ectasia and duct ectasia.

### **Emaciation**

Extreme wasting and loss of body mass, especially muscle and fat, caused by severe illness, malnutrition, or other chronic conditions.

### **Embolus**

A detached intravascular mass, such as a blood clot, fat droplet, air bubble, or other material, that travels through the circulation and may obstruct a vessel.

### **Embryology**

The study of development from fertilization through the embryonic and fetal stages, including the formation of organs and body structures.

### **Emollient**

A substance applied to the skin to soften and moisturize it by reducing water loss and improving the skin barrier. Emollients are commonly used in eczema and dry skin.

### **Endarterectomy**

Surgical removal of atherosclerotic plaque and diseased inner lining from an artery to improve blood flow, commonly performed in the carotid arteries.

### **Enteropathy**

A disease or disorder affecting the intestine. Causes include infection, inflammation, gluten sensitivity, impaired blood flow, toxins, and inherited conditions.

### **Exhalation**

The process of breathing air out of the lungs. It is normally passive at rest but becomes active during exercise or respiratory distress.

### **Extrapyramidal System**

Neural pathways and brain structures, including the basal ganglia, that help regulate movement, muscle tone, posture, and automatic motor activity.

### **Extremity**

A limb of the body, including the upper extremity (shoulder, arm, forearm, wrist, and hand) or lower extremity (hip, thigh, leg, ankle, and foot).

### **Extrinsic Allergic Alveolitis (Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis)**

An immune-mediated inflammation of the lung caused by repeated inhalation of sensitizing organic particles, such as moulds, animal proteins, or contaminated agricultural dust.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis

### **Eyeball (Globe)**

The roughly spherical organ of vision, consisting of the cornea, sclera, uveal tract, lens, retina, and internal chambers and fluids.

#### **Synonyms:**

Globe

### **Eyebrow**

A strip of hair above the orbit that helps protect the eye from sweat, moisture, and particles.

### **Eye Drops**

Liquid preparations instilled into the conjunctival sac for diagnosis, lubrication, or treatment of eye conditions. They should be used according to clinical or product instructions.

### **Eyelashes**

Short, curved hairs arising from the eyelid margins that help protect the ocular surface from foreign particles and excessive light.

### **Eyelids**

Mobile folds of skin and muscle that protect the eyes, spread the tear film, and help regulate the amount of light entering the eye.

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## Eyesight (Vision)

The ability to perceive and interpret light, form, color, movement, and detail through the eyes and visual pathways of the nervous system.

### Synonyms:

Vision

## Ear Cartilage

Ear cartilage denotes ear cartilage, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Ear Disease

A disorder of the outer, middle, or inner ear causing pain, drainage, hearing loss, tinnitus, dizziness, infection, or balance disturbance.

## Ear Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting ear neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Early Diagnosis

Early diagnosis refers to early diagnosis, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Early Endosome

Early endosome refers to early endosome, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eat

To consume food; nutritional needs and safe intake depend on age, health conditions, swallowing ability, and dietary requirements.

## Ebolavirus

Ebolavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Eccentrocyte Count

Eccentrocyte count is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## Eccrine Porocarcinoma

A rare malignant skin adnexal tumor arising from eccrine sweat-gland ducts; it usually presents as a slowly enlarging nodule or plaque and may recur or metastasize, so biopsy and complete excision are important.

## Eccrine Poroma

A usually benign tumor arising from the eccrine sweat-gland duct, commonly presenting as a flesh-colored or reddish nodule on the hands or feet.

## Ecdysone

A steroid hormone in insects and other arthropods that triggers moulting and metamorphosis; it is relevant mainly to entomology and experimental biology, not routine human therapy.

## Echinacea

Echinacea is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Echinococcus Multilocularis

Echinococcus multilocularis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Echinococcus Vogeli

Echinococcus vogeli is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Echinodermata

Echinodermata is a medical term whose precise

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meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Echinomycin**

A medicine or chemical compound called echinomycin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Echolocation**

Echolocation is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Echothiophate Iodide**

An irreversible cholinesterase inhibitor formerly used topically to reduce intraocular pressure in glaucoma or produce prolonged miosis; systemic cholinergic toxicity is a major risk.

### **Econazole**

A topical imidazole antifungal that inhibits fungal ergosterol synthesis and treats dermatophyte or Candida skin infections; local irritation or contact dermatitis may occur.

### **Ecotoxicology**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving ecotoxicology; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Ectomesenchymoma**

Ectomesenchymoma is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ectopic Tissue**

Ectopic tissue denotes ectopic tissue, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Ectoplasm**

Ectoplasm is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ectromelia**

Ectromelia is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eculizumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called eculizumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Edatrexate**

An investigational antifolate related to methotrexate, studied as an anticancer drug by disrupting folate-dependent DNA synthesis.

### **Edema Trunk**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in the soft tissues of the chest or abdomen, producing swelling from heart, kidney, liver, lymphatic, venous, inflammatory, or medication-related causes.

### **Edetic Acid**

EDTA, a compound that binds metal ions; it is used as a laboratory anticoagulant, preservative, chelating agent, and component of selected medical treatments.

### **Edodekin Alfa**

A clinical condition or finding involving edodekin alfa. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Edotecarin**

A clinical condition or finding involving edotecarin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Edrecolomab**

A medicine or chemical compound called edrecolomab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks

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depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Edwardsiella**

Edwardsiella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Edwardsiella Hoshinae**

A biomedical term referring to edwardsiella hoshinae; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Edwardsiella Ictaluri**

A biomedical term referring to edwardsiella ictaluri; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Edwardsiella Tarda**

A biomedical term referring to edwardsiella tarda; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Efalizumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called efalizumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Efaproxiral**

A clinical condition or finding involving efaproxiral. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Efavirenz**

A medicine or chemical compound called efavirenz. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Effectiveness**

The degree to which an intervention produces its intended outcome in routine practice, as distinct

from efficacy under ideal study conditions.

### **Efferent Nerve**

Efferent nerve is a nerve pathway or nerve-related structure that carries signals between the nervous system and its target; symptoms depend on the site of involvement.

### **Efferent Pathway**

Efferent pathway is a nerve pathway or nerve-related structure that carries signals between the nervous system and its target; symptoms depend on the site of involvement.

### **Eflornithine**

A medicine that inhibits ornithine decarboxylase; topical use reduces unwanted facial hair, while intravenous use has been used against selected trypanosome infections.

### **Egg Shell**

Egg shell is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eggerthella**

Eggerthella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Eggerthella Lenta**

A biomedical term referring to eggerthella lenta; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Ehrlichia**

A biomedical term referring to ehrlichia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Eicosadienoic Acid**

A 20-carbon polyunsaturated fatty acid with two double bonds, present in membrane lipids and stud-

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ied as a precursor in inflammatory and metabolic pathways.

### **Eicosanoid**

Eicosanoid is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eicosanoid Degradation**

Eicosanoid degradation is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eicosanoid Metabolism**

Eicosanoid metabolism is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eicosanoid Receptor**

A cell-surface or nuclear receptor that responds to prostaglandins, leukotrienes, thromboxanes, or related lipid mediators and regulates inflammation, vascular tone, or smooth muscle.

### **Eicosapentaenoic Acid**

The omega-3 fatty acid EPA, found in oily fish and supplements, incorporated into membranes and used to produce signaling mediators with generally less inflammatory activity than arachidonic-acid products.

### **Eicosatetraenoic Acid**

A 20-carbon fatty acid with four double bonds; the best-known form is arachidonic acid, a membrane precursor of prostaglandins, leukotrienes, and other eicosanoids.

### **Eicosatrienoic Acid**

A 20-carbon fatty acid with three double bonds that can serve as a membrane lipid or precursor for biologically active lipid mediators.

### **Eicosenoic Acid**

A 20-carbon monounsaturated fatty acid found in some plant and marine oils and incorporated into

cellular and dietary lipids.

### **Eikenella**

Eikenella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Eikenella Corrodens**

A biomedical term referring to eikenella corrodens; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Elastic Fiber**

Elastic fiber is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Elastic Tissue**

Elastic tissue denotes elastic tissue, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Elasticity**

Elasticity is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Elastics**

Elastics is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Elastofibroma**

Elastofibroma is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Elastomer**

Elastomer is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings,



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and source definition.

### **Elastosis**

Elastosis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Elbow**

Elbow refers to elbow, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Elbow Extensor**

Elbow extensor refers to elbow extensor, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Elbow Flexors**

Elbow flexors refers to elbow flexors, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Elective Abortion**

A planned termination of pregnancy, performed with medication or a procedure according to gestational age, patient preference, and local clinical requirements.

### **Electric Impedance**

Electric impedance is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Electric Organ**

Electric organ denotes electric organ, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Electrical Alternans**

Beat-to-beat variation in ECG QRS amplitude or axis, classically caused by a swinging heart in a large pericardial effusion and potentially indicating tamponade.

### **Electrical Conductance**

Electrical conductance refers to electrical conductance, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Electrical Synapse**

Electrical synapse is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Element**

Element is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Elesclomol Sodium**

A clinical condition or finding involving elesclomol sodium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eligible**

Eligible is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Elinafide**

A clinical condition or finding involving elinafide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Elixir**

Elixir is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Elizabethkingia**

A biomedical term referring to elizabethkingia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

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### **Elliptocyte Count**

Elliptocyte count is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Elongin**

Elongin is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Elotuzumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called elotuzumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Eltrombopag**

A clinical condition or finding involving eltrombopag. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eltrombopag Olamine**

A clinical condition or finding involving eltrombopag olamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Embryo Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting embryo neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Embryogenesis**

The sequence of fertilization, cell division, differentiation, migration, and organ formation through which an embryo develops.

### **Embryonal Carcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting embryonal carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Embryonal Rhabdomyosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting embryonal rhabdomyosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor

type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Embryonic**

Embryonic is a developmental, genetic, reproductive, or family-related term describing a stage, trait, relationship, or pregnancy history; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **Embryonic Cell**

A cell of an early embryo capable of division and differentiation into specialized tissues; embryonic stem cells have broad developmental potential.

### **Embryonic Induction**

Embryonic induction refers to embryonic induction, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Embryonic Mosaic**

Embryonic mosaic is a developmental, genetic, reproductive, or family-related term describing a stage, trait, relationship, or pregnancy history; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **Embryonic Stage**

Embryonic stage is a developmental, genetic, reproductive, or family-related term describing a stage, trait, relationship, or pregnancy history; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **Emergency Care**

Immediate assessment and treatment for a potentially serious or time-sensitive illness or injury.

### **Emitefur**

A clinical condition or finding involving emitefur. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Emodin**

Emodin is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

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## Emotion

Emotion is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Emotional Adjustment

Emotional adjustment is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Emotional Dependency

Emotional dependency is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Empathy

Empathy is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Empedobacter

Empedobacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Empedobacter Brevis

Empedobacter brevis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Empedobacter Falsenii

Empedobacter falsenii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Employee

Employee is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Employment Status

Employment status is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Emtricitabine

A clinical condition or finding involving emtricitabine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Emulsion

Emulsion is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Enalapril

A medicine or chemical compound called enalapril. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Enalaprilat

A medicine or chemical compound called enalaprilat. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Enamel Organ

Enamel organ denotes enamel organ, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

## Enanthema

Enanthema is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

## Encephalitis Virus

Encephalitis virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

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### **Encephalitozoon**

A biomedical term referring to encephalitozoon; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Enchondroma**

Enchondroma is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Enchondromatosis**

Enchondromatosis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Enclomiphene**

A clinical condition or finding involving enclomiphene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **End Point**

End point is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endarteritis**

Endarteritis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endemic Diseases**

Diseases that persist at a predictable baseline in a defined population or region, including infections shaped by local ecology, immunity, behavior, and healthcare access.

### **Endemic Goiter**

Enlargement of the thyroid occurring commonly in a population, classically from insufficient iodine intake and sometimes associated with thyroid dysfunction.

### **Endocannabinoid**

Endocannabinoid is a medical term whose precise

meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endocervical**

Endocervical is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endocrine**

Endocrine is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endocrine Disease**

A disorder of hormone-producing glands or hormone action, causing abnormal growth, metabolism, reproduction, stress responses, or fluid and electrolyte regulation.

### **Endocrine Finding**

Endocrine finding is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endocrine Function**

Endocrine function is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endocrine Gland**

Endocrine gland denotes endocrine gland, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Endocrine Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting endocrine neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

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### **Endocrinologists**

Endocrinologists is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endodontics**

Endodontics is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endodontist**

Endodontist is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endogenous Opiates**

Endogenous opiates is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endogenous Retrovirus**

Endogenous retrovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Endolimax**

Endolimax is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Endolimax Nana**

Endolimax nana is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Endolymph**

Endolymph is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endometrial**

Endometrial is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Endometrial Adenocarcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting endometrial adenocarcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Endometrial Carcinoma**

A neoplastic process affecting endometrial carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Endometrial Disorder**

A disorder of the uterine lining, including abnormal growth, inflammation, polyps, endometriosis-related change, hyperplasia, or cancer, often causing abnormal bleeding or infertility.

### **Endometrial Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting endometrial neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Endometrial Polyp**

Endometrial polyp is an anatomical, embryological, cellular, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Endopeptidase**

Endopeptidase is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endoribonuclease**

Endoribonuclease is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endosome**

Endosome is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose

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location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Endothelial Cell**

A cell lining blood and lymphatic vessels that regulates permeability, clotting, inflammation, vascular tone, and new-vessel formation.

### **Endothelin**

Endothelin concerns endothelin, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Endothelium**

Endothelium is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Endotoxin**

Endotoxin concerns endotoxin, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Energy Increased**

Energy increased is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Energy Intake**

Energy intake is a nutrition or dietary term; appropriate use depends on age, health status, allergies, intake, and medical treatment.

### **Energy Metabolism**

Energy metabolism is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Enflurane**

A clinical condition or finding involving enflurane. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Enfuvirtide**

A medicine or chemical compound called enfuvirtide.

Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Enhanced Pause**

Enhanced pause is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eniluracil**

A clinical condition or finding involving eniluracil. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Enoxaparin**

A medicine or chemical compound called enoxaparin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Enrollment**

Enrollment is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Entamoeba**

Entamoeba is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Entamoeba Coli**

Entamoeba coli is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Entamoeba Hartmanni**

Entamoeba hartmanni is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Entamoeba Polecki**

Entamoeba polecki is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or



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tissue involvement.

### **Enteric Bacteria**

Enteric bacteria is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter**

Enterobacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter Aerogenes**

Enterobacter aerogenes is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter Asburiae**

Enterobacter asburiae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter Cancerogenus**

Enterobacter cancerogenus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter Cloacae**

Enterobacter cloacae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacter Hormaechei**

Enterobacter hormaechei is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobacteriaceae**

Enterobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterobius**

Enterobius is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Enterococcaceae**

Enterococcaceae is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Enterococcus**

Enterococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Avium**

Enterococcus avium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Dispar**

Enterococcus dispar is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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### **Enterococcus Durans**

*Enterococcus durans* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Faecalis**

*Enterococcus faecalis* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Faecium**

*Enterococcus faecium* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Gallinarum**

*Enterococcus gallinarum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Hirae**

*Enterococcus hirae* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Malodoratus**

*Enterococcus malodoratus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Mundtii**

*Enterococcus mundtii* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Pseudoavium**

*Enterococcus pseudoavium* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Raffinosus**

*Enterococcus raffinosus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterococcus Thailandicus**

*Enterococcus thailandicus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Enterocyte**

Enterocyte is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Enterocytozoon**

Enterocytozoon is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Enteroendocrine Cell**

A specialized intestinal epithelial cell that senses nutrients and releases hormones such as GLP-1, GIP, secretin, or CCK to regulate digestion, appetite, and glucose metabolism.

### **Enteromonas Hominis**

*Enteromonas hominis* is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection

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or colonization.

### **Enterostomy Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to enterostomy procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Enterotoxin**

A clinical condition or finding involving enterotoxin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Enterovirus**

Enterovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Entinostat**

Entinostat is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Entorhinal Cortex**

Entorhinal cortex is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Enucleation Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to enucleation procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Environment**

Environment is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Environmental Exposure**

Environmental exposure is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, dura-

tion, and exposure circumstances.

### **Environmental Illness**

Illness caused or worsened by environmental exposures; evaluation requires attention to timing, dose, setting, and alternative explanations.

### **Enzyme Activity**

The rate at which an enzyme catalyzes a reaction under defined conditions, influenced by substrate, temperature, pH, inhibitors, cofactors, and enzyme concentration.

### **Enzyme Deficiency**

Reduced or absent activity of an enzyme, often inherited or acquired, causing accumulation of substrates, lack of products, and characteristic metabolic or cellular disease.

### **Enzyme Inhibitor**

A substance that reduces enzyme activity by binding the active site or another regulatory site, thereby altering a biochemical pathway or therapeutic target.

### **Enzyme Precursors**

Inactive or less-active precursor proteins, also called zymogens, that are converted by cleavage or other modification into functional enzymes.

### **Enzyme Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to enzyme therapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Eosine Yellowish**

Eosine yellowish is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ependymal Cell**

A glial cell lining brain ventricles and the spinal central canal that contributes to cerebrospinal-fluid

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circulation and the ventricular barrier.

### **Ependymal Tumor**

A neoplastic process affecting ependymal tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Ependymoblastoma**

A neoplastic process affecting ependymoblastoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Ephedrine**

A sympathomimetic amine that increases noradrenergic activity and can raise blood pressure and heart rate; it has limited clinical uses and may cause palpitations, insomnia, hypertension, or misuse.

### **Ephrins**

Ephrins is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epiblast**

Epiblast is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Epichlorohydrin**

Epichlorohydrin is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Epidemiologic Method**

A method for measuring disease occurrence or investigating associations between exposures and health outcomes in populations.

### **Epidemiologic Studies**

Research that examines the distribution, causes, risk factors, prevention, or outcomes of health events in populations.

### **Epidemiologist**

Epidemiologist is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epidermal Acanthosis**

Epidermal acanthosis is an anatomical, embryological, cellular, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Epidermal Cells**

Cells forming the outer layer of skin, chiefly keratinocytes, which create a protective barrier; melanocytes, immune cells, and touch-associated cells are also present.

### **Epidermal Growth Factor**

Epidermal growth factor is an anatomical, embryological, cellular, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Epidermophyton**

A biomedical term referring to epidermophyton; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Epidermophyton Floccosum**

A biomedical term referring to epidermophyton floccosum; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Epididymal Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting epididymal neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Epidural Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting epidural neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

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### **Epigallocatechin Gallate**

Epigallocatechin gallate is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epigastric**

Epigastric is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Epigastric Artery**

Epigastric artery denotes epigastric artery, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Epigenome**

Epigenome is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epigenomics**

Epigenomics is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epipodophyllotoxin**

Epipodophyllotoxin concerns epipodophyllotoxin, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Epirubicin**

A clinical condition or finding involving epirubicin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epirubicin Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving epirubicin hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epithalamic**

Epithalamic is a defined medical, biological, or re-

search term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Epithelial**

Epithelial is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Epithelial Cyst**

Epithelial cyst is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Epithelioid Cell**

A rounded or polygonal cell resembling epithelial cells, often describing activated macrophages in granulomas or the appearance of selected tumors.

### **Epithelioma**

Epithelioma is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epitope**

Epitope concerns epitope, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Epitope Mapping**

Epitope mapping concerns epitope mapping, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Eplerenone**

A clinical condition or finding involving eplerenone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epoetin Alfa**

A clinical condition or finding involving epoetin alfa. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Epoetin Beta**

A clinical condition or finding involving epoetin beta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epoprostenol**

A clinical condition or finding involving epoprostenol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epothilon**

Epothilon is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Epothilone B**

A clinical condition or finding involving epothilone b. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epothilone D**

A clinical condition or finding involving epothilone d. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epoxide Hydrolase**

A clinical condition or finding involving epoxide hydrolase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epoxy Compounds**

Epoxy compounds concerns epoxy compounds, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Eptifibatide**

A clinical condition or finding involving eptifibatide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Equilin**

Equilin is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Equine Morbillivirus**

Equine morbillivirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Equinovarus Deformity**

A foot deformity combining downward pointing and inward turning, often congenital or neuromuscular and commonly called clubfoot when present at birth.

### **Equipment Safety**

Practices that reduce injury, infection, malfunction, and misuse of medical equipment through selection, inspection, cleaning, maintenance, and training.

### **Equivalence Trial**

Equivalence trial is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **ErbB Receptors**

A family of receptor tyrosine kinases, including EGFR/HER1 and HER2, that respond to growth factors and regulate proliferation, survival, and differentiation; abnormal signaling drives some cancers.

### **Erbium**

Erbium is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ergocalciferol**

Ergocalciferol is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ergolines**

Ergolines is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.



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### **Ergosterol**

Ergosterol is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ergotamine**

A clinical condition or finding involving ergotamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eribulin Mesylate**

A clinical condition or finding involving eribulin mesylate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erlotinib Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving erlotinib hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erosion Lesion**

A superficial epithelial defect caused by loss of the surface layer of skin or mucosa, without the deep tissue loss of an ulcer.

### **Erratic Results**

Erratic results is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ertapenem**

A clinical condition or finding involving ertapenem. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erucic Acid**

A 22-carbon monounsaturated fatty acid found in mustard and rapeseed oils; high exposure has raised cardiac safety concerns in some animal studies.

### **Erucic Acids**

Long-chain monounsaturated fatty acids of the erucic-acid family, found mainly in certain plant oils and metabolized according to chain length and dietary exposure.

### **Eryptosis**

Eryptosis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Erysipelothrix**

Erysipelothrix is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Erythroblast**

Erythroblast is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Erythrocyte Membrane**

Erythrocyte membrane denotes erythrocyte membrane, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Erythrodysplasia**

Abnormal development or maturation of red blood cells, usually referring to ineffective erythropoiesis in marrow or a dysplastic blood disorder.

### **Erythroid Hyperplasia**

Erythroid hyperplasia is an anatomical, embryological, cellular, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Erythroleukoplakia**

A mixed red-and-white oral mucosal lesion with a high risk of severe dysplasia or cancer, requiring specialist examination and often biopsy.

### **Erythromycin**

A medicine or chemical compound called erythromycin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

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### **Erythromycin Estolate**

A medicine or chemical compound called erythromycin estolate. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Erythroplasia**

A sharply demarcated red lesion of skin or mucosa; persistent oral or genital erythroplasia can represent severe dysplasia or carcinoma in situ.

### **Erythropoietin Receptor**

A cell-surface receptor on erythroid precursor cells that responds to erythropoietin and promotes red-cell survival, proliferation, and maturation.

### **Erythrosine**

A clinical condition or finding involving erythrosine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Escape Reaction**

Escape reaction is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Escherichia**

Escherichia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Albertii**

Escherichia albertii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Blattae**

Escherichia blattae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Coli Infection**

Escherichia coli infection is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Fergusonii**

Escherichia fergusonii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Hermannii**

Escherichia hermannii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escherichia Vulneris**

Escherichia vulneris is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Escitalopram**

A clinical condition or finding involving escitalopram. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Esomeprazole**

A medicine or chemical compound called esomeprazole. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Esomeprazole Magnesium**

A medicine or chemical compound called esomeprazole magnesium. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Esophageal**

Relating to the esophagus, the muscular tube that transports swallowed food and liquid from the pharynx to the stomach.

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## Esophageal Bleeding

Hemorrhage arising from the esophagus, commonly from varices, erosive inflammation, ulceration, tears, or cancer, and potentially presenting as vomiting blood or black stool.

## Esophageal Carcinoma

A neoplastic process affecting esophageal carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Esophageal Duplication

A rare congenital cyst or duplicated segment alongside the esophagus that may compress the airway or esophagus and cause respiratory or swallowing symptoms.

## Esophageal Fistula

An abnormal passage between the esophagus and another organ, most often the airway, causing coughing with swallowing, aspiration, infection, or severe illness.

## Esophageal Infection

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving esophageal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

## Esophageal Necrosis

Death of esophageal lining, classically producing a black-appearing esophagus in severe ischemia, shock, reflux, or caustic injury and carrying a risk of perforation.

## Esophageal Stenosis

Narrowing of the esophageal lumen from scar, inflammation, tumor, radiation, or congenital disease, causing progressive difficulty swallowing.

## Esophageal Ulceration

A break in the esophageal lining caused by reflux, infection, medicines, caustic injury, inflammation, or cancer and capable of causing pain or bleeding.

## Esophagogastric Junction

The transition where the esophagus meets the stomach, including the lower esophageal sphincter and anatomic structures that help prevent reflux.

## Esophagoscope

A flexible or rigid instrument with a light and viewing system used to inspect the esophageal lining and obtain samples or perform treatment.

## Esophagoscopy

Endoscopic examination of the esophagus, usually to investigate dysphagia, bleeding, reflux complications, strictures, foreign bodies, or suspected tumors.

## Esophagus Disease

A disorder of the esophagus causing swallowing difficulty, pain, reflux, regurgitation, bleeding, obstruction, inflammation, motility disturbance, or cancer.

## Esophagus Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting esophagus neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Essiac

Essiac is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Estazolam

A clinical condition or finding involving estazolam. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Ester

Ester is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Esterase

Esterase is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or

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environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Esterification**

Esterification is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Esthesia**

Esthesia is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Esthesiometer**

Esthesiometer is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Estivation**

Estivation is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Estramustine**

A medicine or chemical compound called estramustine. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Estriol**

A clinical condition or finding involving estriol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Estrogen Inhibitor**

Estrogen inhibitor is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Estrone**

A clinical condition or finding involving estrone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Estrous Cycle**

Estrous cycle is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Estrus**

Estrus is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Eszopiclone**

A clinical condition or finding involving eszopiclone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etanercept**

A clinical condition or finding involving etanercept. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etanidazole**

A medicine or chemical compound called etanidazole. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Etaracizumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called etaracizumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Ethacrynic Acid**

A loop diuretic that blocks sodium and chloride reabsorption in the kidney; it can cause substantial fluid loss, low electrolytes, and dose-related ototoxicity.

### **Ethambutol**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethambutol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethane**

Ethane is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the sub-

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stance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethanol**

Ethanol is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethanol Metabolism**

Ethanol metabolism is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethanolamine**

Ethanolamine is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethchlorvynol**

Ethchlorvynol is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethers**

Ethers is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethics**

Principles used to evaluate what is right, fair, respectful, and responsible in healthcare, research, and professional practice.

### **Ethidium**

Ethidium is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethinyl Estradiol**

Ethinyl estradiol is a medical term whose precise

meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethiodized Oil**

Ethiodized oil is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethion**

Ethion is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethionamide**

Ethionamide is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Ethmocephaly**

Ethmocephaly is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethmoid Sinus**

Ethmoid sinus is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethmoid Sinusitis**

Ethmoid sinusitis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethnicity**

Ethnicity is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethoglucid**

Ethoglucid is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

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### **Ethosuximide**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethosuximide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethoxzolamide**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethoxzolamide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethyl Ether**

Ethyl ether is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethyl Methanesulfonate**

Ethyl methanesulfonate is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylene**

Ethylene is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylene Chlorohydrin**

Ethylene chlorohydrin is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylene Dibromide**

Ethylene dibromide is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylene Oxide**

Ethylene oxide is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylenethiourea**

Ethylenethiourea is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Ethylnitrosourea**

Ethylnitrosourea is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethynodiol Diacetate**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethynodiol diacetate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etidronic Acid**

A bisphosphonate that binds bone mineral and inhibits osteoclast-mediated bone resorption; it is also used as a chelating or scale-control agent in other settings.

### **Etilefrine**

A clinical condition or finding involving etilefrine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etiocholanolone**

Etiocholanolone is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Etioplast**

Etioplast is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Etodolac**

A clinical condition or finding involving etodolac. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etomidate**

A clinical condition or finding involving etomidate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.



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agement depend on the clinical context.

### **Etoposide**

A clinical condition or finding involving etoposide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etoposide Phosphate**

A clinical condition or finding involving etoposide phosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etoricoxib**

A clinical condition or finding involving etoricoxib. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etretinate**

A clinical condition or finding involving etretinate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eubacterium**

Eubacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Eubacterium Limosum**

Eubacterium limosum is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Eubacterium Rectale**

Eubacterium rectale is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Eubacterium Ventriosum**

Eubacterium ventriosum is a microorganism or mi-

crobial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Eucalyptus Oil**

An essential oil containing compounds such as eucalyptol; ingestion can be toxic, and concentrated oil should not be used internally without appropriate medical guidance.

### **Euchromatin**

Euchromatin concerns euchromatin, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Euglena**

Euglena is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Eukaryote**

Eukaryote is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Eukaryotic Cell**

A cell with a membrane-bound nucleus and specialized organelles, including the cells of animals, plants, fungi, and protists.

### **Europium**

Europium is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Eurotium**

Eurotium is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Everolimus**

A clinical condition or finding involving everolimus. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and man-

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agement depend on the clinical context.

### **Evolution**

Evolution is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ewingella**

Ewingella is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Ewingella Americana**

A rare Gram-negative environmental bacterium that can occasionally cause opportunistic infection, mainly in people with underlying illness.

### **Ewings Sarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting ewings sarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Exacerbation**

A worsening or flare of a disease or its symptoms, sometimes triggered by infection, exposure, treatment interruption, or another stressor.

### **Examination Table**

A table designed to support a patient during a physical examination or clinical procedure.

### **Exatecan Mesylate**

A clinical condition or finding involving exatecan mesylate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Excessive Bruising**

Bruising that is unusually frequent, large, spontaneous, or prolonged and may reflect trauma, medications, low platelets, clotting disorders, or another illness.

### **Excision Biopsy**

Removal of an entire lesion or abnormal area for microscopic examination, when complete removal is

appropriate and feasible.

### **Excitatory Synapse**

Excitatory synapse is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Executive Function**

Executive function is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Exemestane**

A clinical condition or finding involving exemestane. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exenatide**

A clinical condition or finding involving exenatide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exencephaly**

Exencephaly is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exenteration**

Exenteration is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exercise Tolerance**

The ability to perform physical activity before symptoms such as breathlessness, fatigue, chest discomfort, or pain limit activity.

### **Exfoliation Syndrome**

An age-related disorder in which abnormal fibrillar material accumulates in the anterior eye, increasing risk of glaucoma, zonular weakness, and surgical complications.

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### **Exhibitionism**

Exhibitionism is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exiguobacterium**

Exiguobacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Exocervix**

Exocervix refers to exocervix, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Exocrine Gland**

Exocrine gland denotes exocrine gland, an anatomical structure or tissue whose clinical importance depends on location, connections, blood supply, innervation, and function.

### **Exocrine Pancreas**

Exocrine pancreas is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Exodeoxyribonuclease**

Exodeoxyribonuclease is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exonuclease**

Exonuclease is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exopeptidase**

Exopeptidase is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exophiala**

Exophiala is a microorganism or biological taxon;

its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Exophiala Dermatitidis**

Exophiala dermatitidis is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Expectorant**

A medicine intended to help loosen or mobilize respiratory mucus so it can be coughed up; benefit varies by cause and product.

### **Experience**

Experience is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exposure**

Contact with a physical, chemical, biological, or psychological agent at a particular intensity and duration; risk depends on the agent and circumstances.

### **Exserohilum**

Exserohilum is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Extent**

Extent is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **External Capsule**

A thin white-matter tract lateral to the putamen that carries connections among the cerebral cortex, thalamus, basal ganglia, and other regions.

### **External Ear**

The visible auricle and external auditory canal that collect and conduct sound toward the tympanic membrane and help protect the middle ear.

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### **External Nose**

The projecting nasal structure formed by bone, cartilage, skin, and soft tissue that shapes the nasal airway and supports smell and facial appearance.

### **Extraamniotic**

Extraamniotic is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Extracellular Exosome**

A small membrane vesicle released by cells that carries proteins, lipids, and nucleic acids to other cells and participates in intercellular signaling.

### **Extracellular Region**

The space outside cells containing extracellular matrix, signaling molecules, ions, fluid, and other substances that influence tissue structure and cell behavior.

### **Extracellular Space**

The fluid-filled and matrix-containing environment outside cells through which nutrients, waste, hormones, and signals move.

### **Extracellular Vesicle**

A membrane-bound particle released by a cell that transfers molecular cargo between cells and is studied in physiology, disease, biomarkers, and drug delivery.

### **Extracorporeal Circulation**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to extracorporeal circulation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Extraction**

Removal of a substance, tissue, tooth, foreign body, or other structure from the body, usually by a defined procedure.

### **Extranodal**

Extranodal is a medical term whose precise meaning

depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Extraocular**

Extraocular is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Extraocular Muscle**

Extraocular muscle is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Extraskkeletal Osteosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting extraskkeletal osteosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Extrinsic**

Extrinsic is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Eye Development**

Eye development refers to eye development, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Eye Disorder**

A disease of the eye or visual pathways causing altered vision, pain, redness, discharge, double vision, field loss, or other ocular findings.

### **Eye Hemorrhage**

Eye hemorrhage refers to eye hemorrhage, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Eye Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving eye infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

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## Eye Injury

Eye injury refers to eye injury, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eye Movement

Eye movement refers to eye movement, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eye Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting eye neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Eye Prosthesis

Eye prosthesis refers to eye prosthesis, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eyeglass

Eyeglass refers to eyeglass, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eyelash

Eyelash refers to eyelash, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eyelid

Eyelid refers to eyelid, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eyelid Coloboma

Eyelid coloboma refers to eyelid coloboma, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Eyelid Disorder

A disease or structural problem of the eyelid, such as inflammation, infection, malposition, tumor, or gland blockage, that can affect comfort or protect the eye.

## Eyelid Neoplasm

A neoplastic process affecting eyelid neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Ezetimibe

A clinical condition or finding involving ezetimibe. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Elbow Pain

Elbow pain is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### Synonyms:

Pain Elbow (Elbow Pain)

## Excessive Sweating

Sweating more than needed for temperature control, either generally or in specific areas; causes include hyperhidrosis, medicines, infection, hormonal changes, or other medical conditions.

## Eye Twitching

Repeated involuntary spasms of an eyelid or muscles around the eye, commonly associated with fatigue, stress, caffeine, irritation, or eye strain.

## E. Coli

A group of bacteria that normally inhabit the intestines, some strains of which cause diarrheal illness, urinary infections, or other infections.

## Ear Infection (Middle Ear)

Infection or inflammation in the space behind the eardrum, often causing ear pain, fever, hearing changes, or irritability in children.

## Eating Disorders

Serious mental and physical health conditions involving disturbed eating behaviors, body image, and relationships with food and weight.

## Ehrlichiosis And Anaplasmosis

Tick-borne bacterial infections that commonly cause

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fever, headache, muscle aches, and low blood-cell counts.

### **Elevated Blood Pressure**

Blood pressure consistently above the healthy range, increasing long-term risk of heart, brain, kidney, and vascular disease.

### **Embryonal Tumors**

Cancers that arise from cells resembling developing embryonic tissue, often occurring in children and commonly affecting the nervous system.

### **Enlarged Breasts In Men (Gynecomastia)**

Enlargement of male breast tissue caused by hormonal imbalance, medicines, substance use, or an underlying illness.

### **Enlarged Liver**

Enlarged liver concerns enlarged liver, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Liver, Enlarged

### **Enlarged Heart**

An increase in the size of the heart, which may result from high blood pressure, valve disease, cardiomyopathy, anemia, or other conditions and requires evaluation of the underlying cause.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardiomegaly

### **Enlarged Spleen (Splenomegaly)**

An increase in spleen size associated with infection, liver disease, blood disorders, inflammation, or malignancy.

### **Extranodal Marginal Zone Lymphoma Of Mucosa-Associated Lymphoid Tissue (MALT)**

A usually slow-growing B-cell lymphoma arising in mucosal tissues such as the stomach, salivary glands, thyroid, or lungs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Extranodal Marginal Zone Lymphoma MALT Lymphoma Mucosa-Assisted Lymphoid Tissue Lymphoma

### **Epithelioid Sarcoma**

A rare soft-tissue cancer that often begins in the skin or tissues of the hands, forearms, or lower limbs.

### **Esophageal Spasms**

Uncoordinated or forceful contractions of the esophagus that can cause chest pain and difficulty swallowing.

### **Esthesioneuroblastoma**

A rare cancer arising from specialized nerve tissue in the upper nasal cavity, potentially causing nasal obstruction, bleeding, or loss of smell.

### **Ear Infection, Outer Ear**

Alternate index label; see *Swimmer's ear*.

### **Eardrum, Ruptured**

Alternate index label; see *Ruptured eardrum (perforated eardrum)*.

### **Early Puberty**

Alternate index label; see *Precocious puberty*.

### **Eating Disorders, Anorexia**

Alternate index label; see *Anorexia nervosa*.

### **Eating Disorders, Binge Eating**

Alternate index label; see *Binge-eating disorder*.

### **Eating Disorders, Bulimia**

Alternate index label; see *Bulimia nervosa*.

### **Eczema, Dyshidrotic**

Alternate index label; see *Dyshidrosis*.

### **Edema, Pulmonary**

Alternate index label; see *Pulmonary edema*.



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### **Epicondylitis, Lateral**

Alternate index label; see *Tennis elbow*.

### **Epilepsy, Frontal Lobe**

Alternate index label; see *Frontal lobe seizures*.

### **Excess Facial Hair In Women**

Alternate index label; see *Hirsutism*.

### **Excessive Daytime Sleepiness**

Alternate index label; see *Narcolepsy*.

### **Excessive Menstrual Bleeding**

Alternate index label; see *Heavy menstrual bleeding*.

### **Extrahepatic Biliary Atresia**

Alternate index label; see *Biliary atresia*.

### **Extranodal Marginal Zone Lymphoma**

Alternate index label; see *Extranodal marginal zone lymphoma of mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue (MALT)*.

### **Extrasystole**

Alternate index label; see *Premature ventricular contractions (PVCs)*.

### **Eyelid Inflammation**

Alternate index label; see *Blepharitis*.

### **E-Cigarettes And E-Hookahs**

Electronic nicotine-delivery devices that heat a liquid aerosol; they can cause nicotine dependence and expose users and bystanders to irritants and toxic chemicals.

### **Ear - Blocked At High Altitudes**

Ear - blocked at high altitudes concerns ear - blocked at high altitudes, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Ear Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning ear discharge. It

addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Ear Drainage Culture**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess ear drainage culture. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Ear Emergencies**

Ear emergencies concerns ear emergencies, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Ear Examination**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess ear examination. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Ear Infection - Acute**

A clinical condition or finding involving ear infection - acute. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ear Infection - Chronic**

A clinical condition or finding involving ear infection - chronic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ear Tag**

Ear tag concerns ear tag, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Ear Tube Insertion**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to ear tube insertion; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Ear Tube Surgery - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A medical procedure involving ear tube surgery - what to ask your doctor. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the

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specific procedure.

### **Eardrum Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to eardrum repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Earlobe Creases**

Earlobe creases concerns earlobe creases, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Eating Disorders - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning eating disorders - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Eating Extra Calories When Sick - Adults**

A clinical condition or finding involving eating extra calories when sick - adults. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eating Extra Calories When Sick - Children**

A clinical condition or finding involving eating extra calories when sick - children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eating Habits And Behaviors**

A clinical condition or finding involving eating habits and behaviors. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eating Out**

A clinical condition or finding involving eating out. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eating Right During Pregnancy**

A clinical condition or finding involving eating right

during pregnancy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Echocardiogram - Children**

A clinical condition or finding involving echocardiogram - children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ectodermal Dysplasias**

A clinical condition or finding involving ectodermal dysplasias. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **EGD - Esophagogastroduodenoscopy**

An upper endoscopy using a flexible camera to inspect the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum and to obtain biopsies or treat selected lesions.

### **EGD Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning egd discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Eight Ways To Cut Your Health Care Costs**

A patient-care topic concerning eight ways to cut your health care costs. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Elbow Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to elbow replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Elbow Replacement - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to elbow replacement - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Elbow Sprain - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning elbow sprain - af-

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tercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Elder Care - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning elder care - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Electrocauterization**

A clinical condition or finding involving electrocauterization. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electrolytes - Urine**

A clinical condition or finding involving electrolytes - urine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Elephant Ear Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving elephant ear poisoning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Elimination Patterns**

The frequency, timing, amount, and characteristics of urination and bowel movements, which help assess hydration, gastrointestinal function, continence, and disease.

### **ELISA Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess elisa blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Ellis-Van Creveld Syndrome**

Ellis-van Creveld syndrome is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Emergency Airway Puncture**

A clinical condition or finding involving emergency airway puncture. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ending Pregnancy With Medicines**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to ending pregnancy with medicines; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Endocarditis - Children**

Endocarditis - children is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Endocervical Culture**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess endocervical culture. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Endocervical Gram Stain**

Endocervical Gram stain is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Endometrial Polyps**

Localized overgrowths of endometrial tissue projecting into the uterine cavity that may cause irregular bleeding, infertility, or no symptoms.

### **Endoscopic Thoracic Sympathectomy**

A clinical condition or finding involving endoscopic thoracic sympathectomy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Endovascular Embolization**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to endovascular embolization; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Enlarged Adenoids**

Overgrowth of lymphoid tissue behind the nose that can obstruct nasal breathing, cause mouth breathing, snoring, ear-fluid problems, or sleep-disordered breathing.

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## Enlarged Prostate

Increase in prostate size, usually benign prostatic hyperplasia, that can obstruct urine flow and cause hesitancy, weak stream, frequency, urgency, or retention.

### Enlarged Prostate - After Care

A patient-care topic concerning enlarged prostate - after care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### Enlarged Prostate - What To Ask Your Doctor

A patient-care topic concerning enlarged prostate - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Enteral Nutrition - Child - Managing Problems

A patient-care topic concerning enteral nutrition - child - managing problems. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Enteroclysis

A contrast-imaging study in which material is delivered directly into the small intestine through a tube to evaluate mucosal disease, narrowing, or obstruction.

## Enteroscopy

Endoscopic examination of the small intestine, allowing visualization, biopsy, bleeding treatment, or removal of selected lesions beyond the reach of standard upper endoscopy.

## Enzyme Markers

Enzyme markers concerns enzyme markers, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Eosinophil Count - Absolute

A clinical condition or finding involving eosinophil count - absolute. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical

context.

## Epicanthal Folds

Skin folds of the upper eyelid that partly cover the inner canthus, common in some populations and sometimes associated with chromosomal or developmental syndromes.

## Epidural Block - Pregnancy

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to epidural block - pregnancy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Epidural Injections For Back Pain

A medical procedure involving epidural injections for back pain. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

## Epilepsy - Resources

A patient-care topic concerning epilepsy - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Epilepsy In Adults - What To Ask Your Doctor

A patient-care topic concerning epilepsy in adults - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Epilepsy In Children

A neurologic disorder in which a child has recurrent unprovoked seizures or a seizure syndrome, with causes, seizure types, development, and treatment varying widely.

## Epilepsy In Children - Discharge

A patient-care topic concerning epilepsy in children - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Epilepsy In Children - What To Ask Your Doctor

A patient-care topic concerning epilepsy in children

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- what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Epilepsy Or Seizures - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning epilepsy or seizures - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Episiotomy - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning episiotomy - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Epstein-Barr Virus Antibody Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess epstein-barr virus antibody test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **ERCP**

Endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography, a procedure combining endoscopy and contrast imaging to diagnose or treat bile-duct and pancreatic-duct obstruction, stones, leaks, or strictures.

### **Erection Problems**

A clinical condition or finding involving erection problems. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erection Problems - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning erection problems - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Eruptive Xanthomatosis**

Eruptive xanthomatosis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Erysipeloid**

A clinical condition or finding involving erysipeloid. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erythema Toxicum**

A clinical condition or finding involving erythema toxicum. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Erythroplasia Of Queyrat**

Squamous-cell carcinoma in situ of the glans penis or prepuce, appearing as a persistent well-demarcated red velvety plaque.

### **Erythropoietin Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess erythropoietin test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Esophageal Culture**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess esophageal culture. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Esophageal Stricture - Benign**

A clinical condition or finding involving esophageal stricture - benign. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Esophagectomy - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning esophagectomy - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Esophagectomy - Minimally Invasive**

A clinical condition or finding involving esophagectomy - minimally invasive. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Esophagectomy - Open**

A clinical condition or finding involving esophagectomy - open. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Estimated Average Glucose (EAG)**

An estimate of mean blood glucose calculated from

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the hemoglobin A1c result and reported in glucose units that correspond roughly to daily readings.

### **Estradiol Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess estradiol blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Estrogen Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving estrogen overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethanol Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethanol poisoning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethmoiditis**

Ethmoiditis is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Ethylene Glycol Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess ethylene glycol blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Eucalyptus Oil Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving eucalyptus oil overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eugenol Oil Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving eugenol oil overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eustachian Tube Patency**

The ability of the auditory tube to open and equalize pressure between the middle ear and nasopharynx; blockage causes pressure, muffled hearing, or effusion.

### **Excessive Carrying Angle Of The Elbow**

Excessive carrying angle of the elbow concerns excessive carrying angle of the elbow, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Excessive Crying In Infants**

Crying that is unusually prolonged, frequent, or difficult to soothe; it may reflect normal colic but can also signal illness, injury, feeding problems, or unsafe caregiving stress.

### **Excessive Or Unwanted Hair In Women**

Increased hair growth that is cosmetically unwanted or hormonally patterned, including hirsutism from androgen excess and generalized hypertrichosis from other causes.

### **Exercise And Activity - Children**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercise and activity - children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exercise And Activity For Weight Loss**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercise and activity for weight loss. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exercise And Age**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercise and age. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exercise And Immunity**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercise and immunity. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exercise Clothing And Shoes**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercise clothing and shoes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.



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### **Exercise, Lifestyle, And Your Bones**

A biological or anatomical term referring to exercise, lifestyle, and your bones. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Exercises To Help Prevent Falls**

A clinical condition or finding involving exercises to help prevent falls. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exercising And Asthma At School**

Exercising and asthma at school is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **Exercising On A Budget**

Planning safe physical activity with low-cost options such as walking, home exercises, stairs, or community facilities, adapted to health status and fitness goals.

### **Exogenous Cushing Syndrome**

Exogenous Cushing syndrome is a medical term whose precise meaning depends on the clinical context, associated findings, and source definition.

### **External Incontinence Devices**

A clinical condition or finding involving external incontinence devices. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Extremity Angiography**

A clinical condition or finding involving extremity angiography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Extremity X-Ray**

Extremity x-ray is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Eye - Foreign Object In**

A clinical condition or finding involving eye - foreign object in. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eye And Orbit Ultrasound**

A clinical condition or finding involving eye and orbit ultrasound. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eye Burning - Itching And Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning eye burning - itching and discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Eye Emergencies**

Eye emergencies include acute vision loss, chemical injury, penetrating trauma, severe pain, and selected infections or pressure disorders requiring immediate assessment.

### **Eye Muscle Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to eye muscle repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Eye Muscle Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to eye muscle repair - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Eyelid Bump**

Eyelid bump concerns eyelid bump, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Eyelid Drooping**

Eyelid drooping concerns eyelid drooping, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

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### **Eyelid Lift**

Eyelid lift concerns eyelid lift, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Eyelid Twitch**

Eyelid twitch concerns eyelid twitch, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Eyes - Bulging**

Eyes - bulging concerns eyes - bulging, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **E. Coli 0157:H7**

E. coli O157:H7 is a Shiga-toxin-producing strain that can cause severe diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and bloody stool. It may lead to hemolytic uremic syndrome, especially in children; antibiotics and antidiarrheals require careful medical guidance.

### **E. Coli (E. Coli 0157:H7)**

Alternate index label for E. Coli 0157:H7.

### **Ear Object In (Objects Or Insects In Ear)**

Alternate index label for Objects Or Insects In Ear.

### **Earliest Signs Of Increased Intracranial Pressure**

Early increased intracranial pressure may cause worsening headache, vomiting, visual changes, drowsiness, slowed thinking, or a change in behavior. It can result from bleeding, tumor, swelling, infection, or hydrocephalus and requires prompt evaluation when progressive.

### **Earwax (Ear Wax)**

Alternate index label for Ear Wax.

### **EB (Epidermolysis Bullosa (EB))**

Alternate index label for Epidermolysis Bullosa (EB).

### **Ebola Hemorrhagic Fever (Ebola**

### **Hemorrhagic Fever (Ebola HF))**

Alternate index label for Ebola Hemorrhagic Fever (Ebola HF).

### **Ebola Hemorrhagic Fever (Ebola HF)**

Alternate index label for Ebola HF.

### **Ebola Virus Contagious (Is The Ebola Virus Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is the Ebola Virus Contagious.

### **EBV (Epstein-Barr Virus (EBV))**

Alternate index label for Epstein-Barr Virus (EBV).

### **Eclampsia Pregnancy (Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia)**

Alternate index label for Pregnancy: Preeclampsia and Eclampsia.

### **Eczema Facts**

Eczema is a group of itchy inflammatory skin disorders involving barrier dysfunction, dryness, redness, scaling, or oozing. Triggers and subtypes vary, and care combines moisturization, trigger reduction, topical treatment, and management of infection when present.

### **ED (Erectile Dysfunction (ED, Impotence))**

Alternate index label for Erectile Dysfunction (ED, Impotence).

### **Edema Pulmonary (Pulmonary Edema)**

Alternate index label for Pulmonary Edema.

### **EDS (Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome.

### **EEC (Enterovirulent E. Coli (EEC))**

Alternate index label for Enterovirulent E. Coli (EEC).

### **Effusion Pleural (Pleural Effusion (Fluid**

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### **In The Chest Or On Lung))**

Alternate index label for Pleural Effusion (Fluid In the Chest or On Lung).

### **Elastic Skin (Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome.

### **Embolism Pulmonary (Pulmonary Embolism)**

Alternate index label for Pulmonary Embolism.

### **Emotional Dysregulation Disorder (Borderline Personality Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Borderline Personality Disorder.

### **Emphysema (Lung Condition)**

Alternate index label for Lung Condition.

### **Emphysema Vs. COPD (COPD Vs. Emphysema Differences Similarities)**

Alternate index label for COPD vs. Emphysema Differences Similarities.

### **End-Stage COPD: Signs, Symptoms, And Prognosis**

Advanced COPD may cause severe persistent breathlessness, low exercise tolerance, frequent exacerbations, weight loss, oxygen dependence, and respiratory failure. Prognosis varies; pulmonary rehabilitation, inhaled treatment, oxygen when indicated, advance care planning, and palliative support are important.

### **Enlarged Spleen**

An enlarged spleen, or splenomegaly, may result from infection, liver or blood disease, cancer, inflammation, or congestion. It can cause fullness or pain and increases vulnerability to rupture; the cause and blood counts guide evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Spleen Enlarged (Enlarged Spleen)

### **Enteric Fever (Typhoid Fever)**

Alternate index label for Typhoid Fever.

### **Enterovirulent E. Coli (EEC)**

Alternate index label for EEC.

### **Enterovirus (Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection)**

Alternate index label for Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection.

### **Enthesitand Enthesopathy (Enthesitis And Enthesopathy)**

Alternate index label for Enthesitis and Enthesopathy.

### **Enthesitis And Enthesopathy**

Enthesitis is inflammation where a tendon, ligament, or fascia attaches to bone; enthesopathy includes degenerative and other disorders at that site. It is associated with overuse, arthritis, and spondyloarthritis and causes localized pain and stiffness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Enthesitand Enthesopathy (Enthesitis And Enthesopathy)

### **Epidermolysis Bullosa (EB)**

Alternate index label for EB.

### **Epilepsy And Seizures: How To Treat**

Epilepsy is a tendency to recurrent unprovoked seizures caused by abnormal electrical activity in the brain. Treatment may include antiseizure medicine, surgery, dietary therapy, or neuromodulation according to seizure type, cause, risks, and response.

### **Epstein-Barr Virus (EBV)**

Alternate index label for EBV.

### **Erectile Dysfunction (ED, Impotence)**

Alternate index label for ED, Impotence.

### **Erythema Infectiosum (Fifth Disease)**

Alternate index label for Fifth Disease.

### **Eustachian Tube Problems**

Eustachian-tube dysfunction prevents normal pressure equalization and middle-ear drainage, causing

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fullness, popping, muffled hearing, pain, or recurrent infection. Allergies, infection, inflammation, and structural factors contribute; persistent hearing loss or severe pain needs examination.

**Synonyms:**

Tubes Ear Problems (Eustachian Tube Problems)

**Exhaustion Heat (Heat Exhaustion)**

Alternate index label for Heat Exhaustion.

**Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency  
(Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency EPI)**

Alternate index label for Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency EPI.

**Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency EPI**

Exocrine pancreatic insufficiency occurs when the pancreas does not release enough digestive enzymes, causing greasy stools, bloating, weight loss, and deficiencies of fat-soluble vitamins. Pancreatic enzyme replacement and nutritional monitoring are central to treatment.

**Synonyms:**

Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency (Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency EPI)

**Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency (EPI)**

Inadequate pancreatic enzyme secretion causing impaired digestion and absorption, often with greasy stools, weight loss, bloating, and fat-soluble vitamin deficiency.

**Synonyms:**

EPI

**Extrasystole (Premature Ventricular Contractions)**

Alternate index label for Premature Ventricular Contractions.

**Eye Allergy**

An eye allergy is an immune reaction to airborne or contact allergens that causes itching, redness, tearing, and swollen eyelids. Avoidance, cool compresses, lubricants, and appropriate antiallergic drops help; pain or vision loss suggests a different urgent condi-

tion.

**Synonyms:**

Allergy Eye (Eye Allergy)

**Eye Black (Black Eye)**

Alternate index label for Black Eye.

**Eye Care**

Eye care includes protective eyewear, regular examination based on age and risk, control of diabetes and blood pressure, safe contact-lens hygiene, and prompt attention to vision changes. Sudden vision loss, severe pain, flashes, or a curtain-like shadow is urgent.

**Synonyms:**

Eye Care Eye Disorder (Eye Care)

**Eye Care Eye Disorder (Eye Care)**

Alternate index label for Eye Care.

**Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, And Magnifiers**

Eyeglasses correct refractive errors, sunglasses reduce glare and ultraviolet exposure, and magnifiers enlarge near targets for selected visual impairment. Prescription, fit, lens protection, and the underlying eye condition determine the appropriate aid.

**Synonyms:**

Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, And Magnifying Glasses (Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, And Magnifiers)

**Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, And Magnifying Glasses (Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, And Magnifiers)**

Alternate index label for Eyeglasses, Sunglasses, and Magnifiers.

**Eyelid Inflammation (Blepharitis)**

Alternate index label for Blepharitis.

**Ear Cleaning (By A Doctor)**

Professional removal of excess or impacted earwax by a clinician using instruments, suction, irrigation when appropriate, or other safe methods after examining the ear.

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### **Ear Thermometer**

A thermometer that estimates body temperature by detecting infrared radiation from the tympanic membrane and ear canal.

### **Ear, Low-Set**

An ear positioned lower on the head than usual; it may be a normal familial feature or one finding among others in a congenital syndrome.

### **EB (Epidermolysis Bullosa)**

A group of inherited disorders in which skin and sometimes mucous membranes are unusually fragile and blister or erode after minor friction or trauma.

### **EBCT (Electron Beam Computerized Tomography)**

A rapid CT imaging technique using an electron beam to produce images, historically used especially to detect and quantify coronary-artery calcium.

### **EC**

An abbreviation that may mean enteric-coated, emergency contraception, or endothelial cell; the intended meaning depends on context.

### **Echopraxia**

Involuntary imitation or repetition of another person's movements, seen in some neurologic and psychiatric disorders.

### **Eclosion**

Emergence from a protective covering or developmental stage, such as hatching from an egg or emerging from a pupa.

### **Economy Class Syndrome**

A colloquial term for travel-associated deep-vein thrombosis or pulmonary embolism after prolonged immobility, not limited to economy-class travel.

### **Ecstasy**

A common street name for MDMA, a psychoactive stimulant and empathogen that can cause dangerous overheating, dehydration or hyponatremia, cardio-

vascular stress, and neuropsychiatric effects.

### **Ectomy**

A suffix meaning surgical removal or excision, as in appendectomy or mastectomy.

### **Ectoparasite**

A parasite that lives on the external surface of a host, such as a louse, flea, tick, or mite.

### **Ectopic**

Located or occurring in an abnormal position; an ectopic pregnancy implants outside the uterine cavity, most often in a fallopian tube.

### **Edentulous**

Lacking some or all natural teeth.

### **Efferent**

Carrying signals away from a central structure, especially motor or autonomic signals from the central nervous system to muscles or glands.

### **EGFR**

Epidermal growth factor receptor, a cell-surface signaling protein; activating EGFR variants can drive some cancers and may guide targeted treatment.

### **Eisoptrophobia**

An excessive or irrational fear of mirrors, reflections, or seeing oneself in a mirror.

### **Elbow, Cellulitis Of The**

A bacterial infection of the skin and soft tissues around the elbow, causing redness, warmth, swelling, and tenderness and sometimes spreading rapidly.

### **Elbow, Tip Of The**

The olecranon, the bony prominence at the back of the elbow formed by the proximal ulna.

### **Elective**

Planned in advance rather than required urgently; an elective procedure may be scheduled after considering its benefits, risks, and alternatives.

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### **Elective Surgery**

Surgery planned in advance because it is not required immediately to prevent serious harm; it may still be medically necessary.

### **Electrogastrogram**

A recording of the stomach's electrical activity, usually obtained from electrodes on the abdominal skin to assess gastric slow waves and rhythm.

### **Electrophysiology**

The study of electrical activity in living cells and tissues; in clinical medicine it includes tests of heart rhythm and nerve or muscle function.

### **Elevated Hemidiaphragm**

An abnormally high position of one side of the diaphragm on imaging, which can result from volume loss, nerve or muscle dysfunction, abdominal disease, or other causes.

### **Emboli**

Plural of embolus: particles or material carried through the bloodstream that can lodge in a smaller vessel and obstruct blood flow, such as a clot, fat, air, or infected material.

### **Emergency Code**

A hospital alert used to summon a designated response to an urgent event; the meaning of a specific code varies by institution.

### **Emia**

A suffix meaning a condition of the blood or a substance present in the blood, as in anemia or bacteremia.

### **Empiric Risk**

A risk estimate based on observed population or clinical data rather than solely on a theoretical model; the estimate depends on the population and outcome studied.

### **Empirical**

Based on observation, measurement, or experience

rather than only on theory; empirical treatment may begin before a specific cause is confirmed.

### **Enanthem**

A rash or lesion on a mucous membrane, especially inside the mouth; it may occur with infections, inflammatory disorders, or medication reactions.

### **Encapsulated**

Enclosed by a capsule or well-defined layer of tissue; the term may describe an organ, cyst, infection, or tumor and does not by itself establish whether a lesion is benign or malignant.

### **End Stage**

The advanced phase of a disease in which normal function is severely impaired; the exact criteria and treatment options depend on the disease, such as end-stage kidney or liver disease.

### **Endocrinopathy**

A disorder of an endocrine gland or hormone system, causing excessive, deficient, or otherwise abnormal hormone action.

### **Endogenous**

Originating within the body or produced by its cells or tissues, rather than introduced from outside.

### **Endothelial**

Relating to the endothelium, the thin layer of cells lining blood and lymphatic vessels and forming part of other internal surfaces.

### **Endourologist**

A urologist who specializes in minimally invasive procedures performed through the urinary tract or small access sites, such as stone removal or ureteroscopy.

### **Endovaginal Ultrasound**

Ultrasound imaging performed with a probe placed in the vagina to examine pelvic organs, including the uterus, endometrium, ovaries, and early pregnancy.



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## **Enervate**

To weaken, exhaust, or reduce strength and energy; it is a descriptive verb rather than a specific diagnosis.

## **ENT**

Abbreviation for ear, nose, and throat; it commonly refers to the otolaryngology specialty or an otolaryngologist.

## **ENT Physician**

An otolaryngologist, a physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of the ear, nose, throat, and related head and neck structures.

## **Enteral**

Relating to or delivered through the gastrointestinal tract; enteral nutrition provides food through the mouth or a feeding tube into the stomach or intestine.

## **Enteric**

Relating to the intestine or gastrointestinal tract; the term can also describe organisms or infections associated with the intestines.

## **Enteric-Coated**

Covered with a coating designed to resist breakdown in the stomach and dissolve in the less-acidic small intestine.

## **Entero-**

A combining form meaning intestine or bowel, as in enteropathy and enteroscopy.

## **Enterospasm**

A spasm or involuntary contraction of the intestine, which may cause cramping, pain, or altered movement of intestinal contents.

## **Enterostomy**

A surgically created opening from the intestine to the abdominal surface, such as an ileostomy or colostomy, to divert intestinal contents.

## **Entomophobia**

An intense fear of insects that is excessive, persistent, or causes significant distress or avoidance.

## **Enzootic**

Regularly present or persistently maintained in an animal population or geographic area; it is the animal-population counterpart of endemic disease.

## **EOS**

Commonly an abbreviation for eosinophils or an eosinophil count in laboratory reports; the intended meaning should be confirmed from the report's context.

## **EPA**

Abbreviation for eicosapentaenoic acid, an omega-3 polyunsaturated fatty acid found in oily fish and fish-oil supplements.

## **Epi-**

A prefix meaning on, upon, over, or above, as in epidermis and epigastric.

## **Epidermal**

Relating to the epidermis, the outermost layer of the skin.

## **Epidermodysplasia Verruciformis (EV)**

A rare inherited disorder of skin immunity associated with susceptibility to certain human papillomavirus infections, widespread wart-like lesions, and increased risk of some skin cancers.

## **Epizootic**

An outbreak of disease affecting many animals in a population or area at the same time; it is analogous to an epidemic in humans.

## **EPO Test**

A blood test that measures erythropoietin, a hormone that stimulates red-blood-cell production; it may help evaluate anemia or erythrocytosis.

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## Eponym

A name derived from a person, place, or other proper name and used for a disease, sign, procedure, or anatomical structure.

## EPR

Abbreviation for electrophrenic respiration, also called diaphragm pacing, in which electrical stimulation helps activate the diaphragm in selected patients with respiratory muscle paralysis.

## EPT

Abbreviation for estrogen/progestin therapy, treatment using both an estrogen and a progestin, commonly discussed in menopausal hormone therapy when the uterus is present.

## ER

Abbreviation for emergency room or emergency department, the hospital service that evaluates and treats urgent illness and injury.

## Ergophobia

An intense fear of work or of the workplace that is excessive, persistent, or causes significant distress or avoidance.

## Ergot

A fungus, especially *Claviceps purpurea*, that infects grains such as rye and produces alkaloids; ingestion can cause ergotism, with vascular, neurologic, or uterine effects.

## ERT (Estrogen Replacement Therapy)

Treatment with estrogen to relieve menopausal symptoms or replace deficient estrogen; when the uterus is present, a progestogen is generally added to reduce endometrial cancer risk.

## Erythema Chronicum Migrans

The expanding skin lesion of early Lyme disease, usually developing days to weeks after infection with *Borrelia* following a tick bite; it may have central clearing but is not always a classic bull's-eye.

## Erythema Dose

The amount of ultraviolet or other radiation that produces visible redness of the skin; the minimal erythema dose is the lowest amount causing a defined erythematous response.

## Esophagogastric Tamponade

Temporary control of bleeding from esophageal or gastric varices by inflating a balloon device to apply pressure; it is a rescue measure with serious airway and aspiration risks.

## Essential

Necessary or fundamental; in a diagnosis such as essential hypertension, it indicates that no single secondary cause has been identified.

## Essential Fatty Acid

A fatty acid the body cannot make in sufficient amounts and therefore must obtain from food; the main human examples are linoleic acid and alpha-linolenic acid.

## EST (Expressed Sequence Tag)

A short DNA sequence obtained from a transcribed messenger-RNA copy and used as a marker for identifying or locating an expressed gene.

## Estimated Date Of Confinement (EDC)

The estimated date when a pregnancy is expected to reach delivery, also called the estimated due date; it is commonly calculated from the last menstrual period or early ultrasound.

## Estrogens

A group of steroid hormones, including estradiol, that regulate reproductive development, the menstrual cycle, bone, and other tissues; they are produced mainly by the ovaries before menopause and by other tissues at other times.

## Event

An occurrence relevant to health or care, such as a symptom, diagnosis, treatment, complication, or measurable outcome; its precise meaning depends

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on the clinical context.

### **Evolutionarily Conserved Gene**

A gene whose sequence or function has remained similar across species over evolutionary time, suggesting that it performs an important biological function.

### **Exacerbate**

To make a disease, symptom, or other medical problem more severe or troublesome.

### **Exanthem**

A widespread skin eruption, often caused by an infection or medication; measles and drug eruptions are examples.

### **Excise**

To remove tissue or a lesion surgically by cutting it out.

### **Exclamation Point Hair**

A short, broken hair that is narrower at the end away from the scalp and wider near the scalp, classically seen in alopecia areata.

### **Excoriate**

To scratch, abrade, or strip away the surface of the skin; an excoriation is the resulting superficial injury.

### **Exocrine**

Relating to glands that release secretions through ducts onto an epithelial surface or into a body cavity, such as sweat glands or the exocrine pancreas.

### **Exogenous**

Originating outside the body or introduced from an external source, such as an exogenous medication or hormone.

### **Explant**

To remove an implanted device or tissue; an explant can also be a piece of tissue removed from an organism and maintained in laboratory culture.

### **Expulsion, Stage Of**

The second stage of labor, beginning with complete cervical dilation and ending with delivery of the baby.

### **Extracorporeal**

Occurring or performed outside the body; extracorporeal circulation and hemodialysis route blood through an external machine.

### **Extracranial**

Located or occurring outside the skull or cranial cavity.

### **Extracranial Hematoma**

A collection of blood outside the skull or cranial cavity, usually caused by bleeding into soft tissues after injury.

### **Eye Bleed**

Bleeding in or around the eye; a subconjunctival hemorrhage is blood beneath the clear surface membrane and often appears as a painless bright-red patch, while bleeding inside the eye can impair vision and requires medical assessment.

### **Eye Color**

The apparent color of the iris, determined mainly by the amount and distribution of melanin and the way light is scattered; a new or uneven color change can indicate disease or injury.

### **Eyes, Flashing Lights In The**

Brief flashes or streaks of light, called photopsias, often caused by traction on the vitreous or retina; sudden new flashes, especially with floaters or a curtain-like loss of vision, require urgent eye evaluation for a retinal tear or detachment.

### **Epididymides**

The paired coiled ducts on the posterior surface of the testes where sperm mature and are stored before entering the vasa deferentia.

### **Synonyms:**

epididymis

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## Elevated Liver Enzymes

Higher-than-expected blood levels of enzymes released by injured or stressed liver cells, commonly including ALT and AST. Causes range from fatty liver disease and medicines to viral hepatitis, alcohol-related injury, and biliary obstruction; interpretation depends on the pattern and clinical context.

### Synonyms:

Abnormal liver enzymes; elevated hepatic enzymes.

## EGPA (Formerly Churg-Strauss Syndrome)

Eosinophilic granulomatosis with polyangiitis, an autoimmune vasculitis associated with asthma, eosinophilia, and inflammation of small and medium blood vessels.

## Epidermoid Cysts

Slow-growing benign cysts beneath the skin filled with keratin, commonly presenting as a movable lump.

### Synonyms:

Cysts, Epidermoid Cysts, Sebaceous Sebaceous Cysts

## Embolic Stroke (Brain Embolism)

A stroke caused by a clot or other material traveling to and blocking an artery supplying the brain.

### Synonyms:

Brain Embolism Cerebral Embolism

## Ear, Diseases Of

Ear, Diseases of is an ear-related disease or condition; symptoms, examination findings, causes, and treatment depend on the affected structure.

## Ear-Trumpet

Ear-Trumpet is an ear-related disease or condition; symptoms, examination findings, causes, and treatment depend on the affected structure.

## Ebstein's Anomaly

Ebstein's Anomaly is a cardiovascular or circulatory condition, structure, rhythm, or measurement; its clinical meaning depends on cardiac function, blood

flow, and associated findings.

## Ecbolics

A clinical condition or finding involving ecbolics. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Eccentric

Eccentric is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

## Eccrine Glands

Eccrine Glands is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

## Echinococcus

Echinococcus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Echoencephalography

A clinical condition or finding involving echoencephalography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Echography

A clinical condition or finding involving echography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Ectopistes

A clinical condition or finding involving ectopistes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Ectop Parasite

A clinical disorder or finding related to ectop parasite; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

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### **Ectopic Beat**

Ectopic Beat is a cardiovascular or circulatory condition, structure, rhythm, or measurement; its clinical meaning depends on cardiac function, blood flow, and associated findings.

### **Ectopion**

Ectopion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Edrophonium**

A clinical condition or finding involving edrophonium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **EDTA**

A clinical condition or finding involving edta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Effector**

A clinical condition or finding involving effector. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Effervescent Tablets**

A clinical condition or finding involving effervescent tablets. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **EFT**

A clinical condition or finding involving eft. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Egg**

Egg is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Egg-Cell**

Egg-Cell is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its

role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Ego**

Ego is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Ejaculatory Ducts**

Ejaculatory Ducts is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Electric Shock**

A clinical condition or finding involving electric shock. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electrocardiogram (ECG)**

Electrocardiogram (ECG) is a cardiovascular or circulatory condition, structure, rhythm, or measurement; its clinical meaning depends on cardiac function, blood flow, and associated findings.

### **Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)**

A clinical condition or finding involving electroconvulsive therapy (ect). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electrode**

A clinical condition or finding involving electrode. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electroencephalogram (EEG)**

A clinical condition or finding involving electroencephalogram (eeg). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electromyography (EMG)**

A clinical condition or finding involving electromyography (emg). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Electronic Fetal Monitoring**

A clinical condition or finding involving electronic fetal monitoring. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electron Microscope**

A clinical condition or finding involving electron microscope. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Electrosurgery**

A medical procedure involving electrosurgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Elimination**

Elimination is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Embryoma**

Embryoma is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Emergency Medicine**

Emergency Medicine is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Emetine**

A clinical condition or finding involving emetine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eminentia**

A clinical condition or finding involving eminentia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Emotional Disorders**

A clinical disorder or finding related to emotional disorders; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

tions.

### **Empirical Treatment**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to empirical treatment; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Enarthrosis**

A biomedical term referring to enarthrosis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Endamoeba**

A clinical disorder or finding related to endamoeba; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Endangiitis**

A clinical disorder or finding related to endangiitis; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Endergonic**

A clinical condition or finding involving endergonic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Endomorph**

A clinical condition or finding involving endomorph. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Endoparasite**

A clinical disorder or finding related to endoparasite; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Endostosis**

Endostosis is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Endotoxins**

A clinical condition or finding involving endotox-



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ins. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Energy**

Energy is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Ephelides**

A clinical condition or finding involving ephelides. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ephedrinum**

A clinical condition or finding involving ephedrinum. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epidural Anaesthesia**

Epidural Anaesthesia is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Epilepticus, Status**

A clinical disorder or finding related to epilepticus, status; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Epileptiform**

A clinical condition or finding involving epileptiform. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epiphysitis**

Epiphysitis is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Epsom Salts**

A clinical condition or finding involving epsom salts. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Epulis**

Epulis is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Eradication**

Eradication is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Erection**

Erection is a cardiovascular or circulatory condition, structure, rhythm, or measurement; its clinical meaning depends on cardiac function, blood flow, and associated findings.

### **Ergometrine**

A clinical condition or finding involving ergometrine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eruptive Fever**

A clinical disorder or finding related to eruptive fever; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Erythroblastosis Foetalis**

A clinical disorder or finding related to erythroblastosis foetalis; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Erythropoietin (EPO)**

A clinical condition or finding involving erythropoietin (epo). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eskimo Lung**

Eskimo Lung is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

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### **Etacrynic Acid**

Etacrynic Acid is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Ether**

A clinical condition or finding involving ether. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ethyl Chloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving ethyl chloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Etonogestrel**

A clinical condition or finding involving etonogestrel. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eugenicist**

Eugenicist is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Eugenics**

Eugenics is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Eunuch**

A clinical condition or finding involving eunuch. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Eutocia**

A clinical condition or finding involving eutocia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Evacuation**

Evacuation is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Evacuation Of Uterus**

Evacuation of Uterus is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Ewing's Tumour**

A clinical disorder or finding related to ewing's tumour; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Excavation**

Excavation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Excitation**

Excitation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Exclusion Diet**

Exclusion Diet is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Excreta**

A clinical condition or finding involving excreta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exfoliative Cytology**

A clinical condition or finding involving exfoliative cytology. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exhaustion**

Exhaustion is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Exocrine Glands**

Exocrine Glands is an anatomical structure, tis-

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sue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Exomphalos**

A clinical condition or finding involving exomphalos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Exophthalmic Goitre**

A clinical disorder or finding related to exophthalmic goitre; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Exotoxins**

A clinical disorder or finding related to exotoxins; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Expectant Treatment**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to expectant treatment; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Exploratory Operation**

Exploratory Operation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Expression**

Expression is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Extensor**

Extensor is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Extinction**

Extinction is a physiologic, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment, prevention, treatment, or research.

### **Extirpation**

Extirpation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Extra-**

A clinical condition or finding involving extra-. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Extracellular**

Extracellular is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Extra-Dural**

A clinical condition or finding involving extra-dural. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Extrapyramidal Tracts**

Extrapyramidal Tracts is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Extremities**

Extremities is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Extroversion**

Extroversion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Eye Bank**

Eye Bank is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Eye, Diseases Of**

Eye, Diseases of is an anatomical structure, tissue,

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cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Eyesight**

Eyesight is an anatomical structure, tissue, cell, or body process; its location and function explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Endocrinologist**

A physician who specializes in diagnosing and treating disorders of hormones, endocrine glands, metabolism, and related conditions such as diabetes and thyroid disease.

### **ESRD**

Alternate index label; see *End-Stage Renal Disease*.

### **Enhanced Elimination**

Methods used to increase removal of a toxin from the body after absorption, including urinary alkalization, hemodialysis, hemoperfusion, or other extracorporeal treatments when indicated.

### **Epidermolysis Bullosa Acquisita**

An autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease caused by antibodies against type VII collagen in anchoring fibrils; it commonly causes skin fragility and trauma-induced blisters and may scar.

### **Extramammary Paget Disease**

An intraepithelial adenocarcinoma usually affecting apocrine-rich skin such as the vulva, perianal region, or scrotum; it often presents as a persistent eczematous or erythematous plaque and requires biopsy.

### **Erythema Induratum**

A nodular lobular panniculitis, classically associated with tuberculosis but also caused by other conditions, producing recurrent tender nodules and ulcers on the backs of the lower legs.

### **Extra-Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor**

A gastrointestinal-stromal-tumor-type neoplasm arising outside the gastrointestinal tract, most often

in the mesentery, retroperitoneum, or omentum. Diagnosis uses morphology, KIT or DOG1 expression, and molecular testing.

### **Embryonal Tumor Of The Central Nervous System**

A highly cellular malignant pediatric CNS tumor with primitive or embryonal morphology. Diagnosis depends on integrated histologic and molecular classification, and treatment usually combines surgery, radiation when appropriate, and chemotherapy.

### **Endometrioid Carcinoma Of The Vulva**

A rare vulvar adenocarcinoma showing endometrioid differentiation, sometimes arising in ectopic or specialized Müllerian-type tissue; diagnosis requires exclusion of a metastasis from the endometrium or ovary.

### **Esophageal Adenocarcinoma**

A malignant gland-forming tumor of the esophagus, most often arising in the distal esophagus in the setting of Barrett Esophagus. It is associated with chronic gastroesophageal reflux, obesity, smoking, and other risk factors. Progressive dysphagia, weight loss, bleeding, or chest discomfort may occur, although early disease can be asymptomatic. Diagnosis requires endoscopic biopsy, followed by staging to guide multimodal oncologic treatment.

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### False Negative

A test result that indicates a condition is absent when it is actually present.

### Familial Combined Hyperlipidemia

An inherited disorder causing elevated cholesterol, triglycerides, or both.

### Fasting Lipid Profile

A blood test measuring cholesterol and triglyceride levels, usually after fasting.

#### Synonyms:

Lipid panel

### Fast-Twitch Fiber

A skeletal-muscle fiber specialized for rapid, powerful contractions.

#### Synonyms:

Type II muscle fiber

### Fat

A nutrient and energy source composed mainly of lipids.

#### Synonyms:

Lipid

### Fatty Acids

Organic components of fats used for energy and for building cell membranes and signaling molecules.

### Fatty Streak

An early atherosclerotic lesion formed by lipid accumulation in an artery wall.

### Fibrin

A threadlike protein that forms the structural mesh of a blood clot.

### Fibroblast

A connective-tissue cell that produces collagen and other extracellular-matrix components.

### Fibroid

A benign smooth-muscle tumor, most often arising in the uterus.

#### Synonyms:

Uterine leiomyoma

### Fibrous Plaque

A raised arterial lesion containing fibrous tissue and lipid that can narrow the vessel.

#### Synonyms:

Atherosclerotic plaque

### Finasteride

A 5-alpha-reductase inhibitor used for benign prostatic enlargement and some types of hair loss.

### Fixed Joint

A joint with little or no movement, often because bones are joined by dense tissue.

#### Synonyms:

Synarthrosis

### Flaccid

Relaxed, soft, or lacking normal muscle tone or erection.

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**Flare**

A temporary worsening or recurrence of symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

Exacerbation

**Flatus**

Gas passed through the anus.

**Synonyms:**

Intestinal gas

**Flavonoids**

Plant polyphenols found in many fruits, vegetables, teas, and other foods.

**Flex**

To bend a joint and decrease the angle between its bones.

**Synonyms:**

Flexion

**Flight-Or-Fight Response**

The coordinated stress response that prepares the body to confront or escape a perceived threat.

**Synonyms:**

Fight-or-flight response; stress response

**Flow**

A state of highly focused, effortless involvement in an activity, often with reduced awareness of time.

**Foam Cells**

Lipid-filled cells, usually macrophages, that contribute to atherosclerotic plaque.

**Focal Neuropathy**

Damage to a single peripheral nerve or a small group of nerves.

**Synonyms:**

Mononeuropathy

**Focus Words**

Calming words or phrases used to anchor attention during relaxation or stress-management exercises.

**Follicle**

A small sac or tissue structure, such as a hair follicle or ovarian follicle.

**Follicle-Stimulating Hormone**

A pituitary hormone that supports ovarian follicle development and sperm production.

**Synonyms:**

FSH

**Follicular Unit**

A natural hair-growth unit containing one or more follicles and associated structures.

**Follicular Unit Transplantation**

Hair-restoration surgery that transplants individual follicular units to thinning areas.

**Synonyms:**

FUT

**Food Allergies**

Immune reactions to particular food proteins that can cause symptoms ranging from hives to anaphylaxis.

**Synonyms:**

Food allergy

**Forehead Lift**

Cosmetic surgery that reduces forehead lines and raises drooping eyebrows.

**Synonyms:**

Brow lift

**FRAX Tool**

A calculator that estimates a person's ten-year probability of major osteoporotic or hip fracture.

**Synonyms:**

FRAX fracture-risk calculator

**Free Fragment**

A piece of an intervertebral disk that has separated from the main disk.

**Synonyms:**

Sequestered disk fragment



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## Frequency Range

The span from the lowest to highest sound frequencies amplified by a hearing aid.

## Frequency Response

The amount of amplification a hearing aid provides across different sound frequencies.

## Fructose

A simple sugar found naturally in fruit, honey, and some syrups.

### Synonyms:

Fruit sugar

## FSH

Follicle-stimulating hormone, a pituitary hormone involved in ovarian follicle development and sperm production.

### Synonyms:

Follicle-stimulating hormone

## Functional Gastrointestinal Disorders

Digestive symptoms caused by altered gut function without an evident structural disease or infection.

### Synonyms:

Disorders of gut-brain interaction

## Functional Incontinence

Involuntary urine leakage because a person cannot reach or use the toilet in time despite recognizing the need to void.

## Fabry Disease

An X-linked lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient alpha-galactosidase A activity and accumulation of globotriaosylceramide in multiple organs.

## Face Presentation

A fetal presentation in which the neck is hyperextended and the face is the presenting part. The position of the fetal chin influences whether vaginal birth is possible and how labor is managed.

## Facet Joints

Zygapophysial joints connecting adjacent vertebral

articular processes. Orientation varies: cervical (45 degrees, allowing rotation), thoracic (coronal, allowing rotation but limiting flexion/extension), lumbar (sagittal, allowing flexion/extension but limiting rotation). Innervated by medial branches of dorsal rami.

## Facial Edema

Swelling caused by excess fluid in the tissues of the face. Causes include allergy, infection, trauma, kidney or heart disease, and venous obstruction. Sudden swelling of the lips, tongue, or throat with breathing difficulty is an emergency.

## Facelift

Rhytidectomy: a surgical procedure to improve the appearance of the face and neck by removing excess skin and tightening underlying tissues. It can address sagging skin, deep folds, and jowls. Recovery includes swelling and bruising for several weeks.

### Synonyms:

Rhytidectomy

## Facial Nerve Problems

Disorders affecting cranial nerve VII, which controls facial expression, taste from part of the tongue, and some tear and salivary function. Weakness may result from Bell palsy, stroke, infection, trauma, or a tumor. Sudden facial weakness, especially with arm weakness or speech difficulty, requires emergency assessment.

### Synonyms:

Bells Palsy (Facial Nerve Problems) Idiopathic Facial Paralysis (Facial Nerve Problems)

## Facial Hair, Excess In Women

Hirsutism: excessive androgen-dependent hair growth in male-pattern distribution (face, chest, back) in women. Most common cause is polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS). Other causes include adrenal hyperplasia, tumors, and medications. Evaluation includes hormone levels and imaging.

### Synonyms:

Hirsutism

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## Facial Pain

Pain felt in the face that may arise from dental disease, sinus disease, temporomandibular disorders, nerve disorders, infection, or other causes.

## Facial Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of the facial muscles on one side, most commonly caused by Bell palsy (idiopathic cranial nerve VII dysfunction). Other causes include stroke, infection (herpes zoster oticus), trauma, tumor, or Lyme disease. Sudden facial weakness with other neurological signs requires urgent evaluation.

### Synonyms:

Bell's palsy; facial paralysis

## Facial Paralysis

Weakness or loss of movement of the facial muscles caused by dysfunction of the facial nerve or its pathways; sudden onset requires urgent evaluation for stroke.

## Facilitated Diffusion

Passive transport of molecules across cell membranes via specific transmembrane protein carriers or channels, moving substances down their concentration gradient without energy expenditure. Channel-mediated facilitated diffusion uses ion channels (voltage-gated, ligand-gated, or mechanically-gated) for rapid ion movement.

## Factitious Disorder

Presentation of physical or psychological symptoms or imposing injury or disease on another, with the deceptive intention of assuming the sick role. In factitious disorder imposed on self, the individual falsifies signs or symptoms, induces injury or disease, and presents to medical providers.

### Synonyms:

Munchausen Syndrome

## Factor H Deficiency

Autosomal recessive (CFH mutation). Factor H regulates alternative pathway (cofactor for factor I, accelerates decay). Uncontrolled alternative pathway activation → C3 consumption → low C3, nor-

mal C4. Atypical HUS (aHUS): microangiopathic hemolytic anemia, thrombocytopenia, acute kidney injury.

## Factor I Deficiency

Autosomal recessive (CFI mutation). Factor I cleaves C3b/C4b (cofactor: factor H, MCP, C4BP). Uncontrolled complement → low C3, low C4, low factor H. Recurrent pyogenic infections, aHUS, C3 glomerulopathy, SLE-like disease. Treatment: eculizumab for aHUS/C3G; plasma infusion (contains factor I); IVIG.

## Factor V Deficiency

An inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by reduced factor V activity, impairing thrombin generation and fibrin formation. It may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, postoperative bleeding, or severe bleeding in rare cases.

## Factor V Leiden

An inherited factor V variant that reduces sensitivity to activated protein C and increases the risk of venous thromboembolism. The risk varies with zygosity, family history, and other factors.

## Factor V Leiden Mutation

A factor V variant resistant to activated protein C, causing inherited thrombophilia and increased venous thrombosis risk.

## Factor VII

A blood-clotting protein made mainly in the liver that begins the tissue-factor pathway of coagulation. Inherited deficiency can cause abnormal bleeding, ranging from easy bruising to serious bleeding after injury or procedures.

## Factor VIII

A clotting protein that works with factor IX to help form a stable blood clot. Inherited deficiency causes hemophilia A, characterized by prolonged or spontaneous bleeding into joints, muscles, or other tissues.

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### **Facultative Anaerobe**

A microorganism capable of growth under both aerobic and anaerobic conditions, using respiration when a suitable terminal electron acceptor is present and fermentation or anaerobic respiration when it is not.

### **FAD (Flavin Adenine Dinucleotide)**

A flavin-derived redox coenzyme, usually bound tightly to enzymes as a prosthetic group. FAD accepts two hydrogen atoms to form FADH<sub>2</sub>, which donates electrons to the respiratory chain through selected dehydrogenases.

#### **Synonyms:**

Flavin Adenine Dinucleotide

### **Failed Induction Of Labor**

The inability to achieve active labor and progressive cervical change after an adequate trial of induction. Definition: no active labor (cervical change) after at least 12–18 hours of oxytocin with ruptured membranes and adequate contractions. Management: the latent phase may be prolonged (up to 24 hours or more).

### **Failed Intubation**

Inability to successfully place an endotracheal tube after multiple attempts. In the operating room, a failed intubation algorithm is followed: call for help, maintain oxygenation (face mask, supraglottic airway), and decide to wake the patient (if non-emergent) or proceed with a supraglottic airway (if surgery is urgent).

### **Failure To Thrive**

Inadequate growth in children, defined as weight below the 5th percentile or crossing two major percentile lines on growth charts. Causes include caloric insufficiency (neglect, poor feeding), organic disease (congenital heart disease, renal disease), and psychosocial factors.

### **Fainting**

Fainting is a brief loss of consciousness from transient inadequate brain perfusion, often caused by reflex, orthostatic, or cardiac mechanisms; cardiac

warning features require urgent evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

syncope.

### **Falciform Ligament**

A sickle-shaped peritoneal fold that attaches the liver to the anterior abdominal wall and diaphragm, separating the left and right lobes of the liver. It contains the ligamentum teres, the obliterated remnant of the umbilical vein. It may be implicated in rare complications such as internal herniation or necrosis following trauma.

### **Fall**

Unintended change in position to ground. Major cause of morbidity/mortality in elderly. Risk factors: gait/balance impairment, muscle weakness, visual impairment, polypharmacy, environmental hazards, orthostatic hypotension. Prevention: exercise, medication review, vision correction, home modification, hip protectors.

### **Fall Prevention**

Measures that reduce the risk of falling, including strength and balance training, medication review, vision assessment, safer footwear, and environmental modification.

### **Fall Risk**

The likelihood that a person will fall, based on factors such as gait, balance, strength, vision, medicines, orthostatic blood-pressure changes, and the environment.

### **Fall Screening**

Assessment of a person's history and risk factors for falling to guide prevention and further evaluation.

### **Fallen Arches**

Pes planus: flattening of the medial longitudinal arch of the foot. May be flexible (appearing only when standing) or rigid. Can cause foot, ankle, or knee pain, or be asymptomatic. Treatment includes supportive footwear, orthotics, and stretching exercises.

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**Synonyms:**

Pes planus; flat feet

**Fallopian Tube**

The paired muscular tubes (10-12 cm) connecting the ovaries to the uterus, conducting oocytes and sperm and the site of fertilization (usually ampulla). Segments: infundibulum (fimbriae—sweep the oocyte), ampulla, isthmus, intramural.

**Fallopian Tube Cancer**

A rare tumor histologically similar to high-grade serous ovarian carcinoma. Presents with a pelvic mass, pain, or watery discharge; staging and treatment follow the principles of ovarian cancer.

**Fallopian Tube Torsion**

Twisting of the fallopian tube around its pedicle, usually around an underlying mass such as a hydrosalpinx or paraovarian cyst, causing acute pelvic pain and requiring urgent surgical intervention.

**False Ribs**

Ribs 8-10 not articulating directly with the sternum; their cartilages join rib 7's cartilage forming the costal margin. Greater mobility and flexibility of the lower thoracic wall. More susceptible to fractures at their angles due to greater length and less rigid attachment.

**False-Negative Result**

A negative test result in a person who does have the target condition. Causes include inadequate specimen, early or late testing, low organism or biomarker concentration, prior treatment, technical error, and limited test sensitivity.

**False-Positive Result**

A positive test result in a person who does not have the target condition. Causes include limited specificity, cross-reactivity, technical error, contamination, and testing in a low-prevalence population.

**Familial Adenomatous Polyposis**

Hereditary condition with hundreds to thousands of

adenomas throughout the colon caused by germline APC gene mutations with autosomal dominant inheritance. Polyps develop during the second decade and colorectal cancer occurs by age forty if untreated. Diagnosis is by colonoscopy showing numerous polyps and genetic testing.

**Familial Hypercholesterolemia**

An inherited disorder causing persistently high low-density lipoprotein cholesterol, usually because of impaired LDL-receptor pathway function. It increases the risk of premature atherosclerotic disease; diagnosis uses lipid levels, family history, physical findings, and genetic testing when available.

**Familial Hypocalciuric Hypercalcemia**

Autosomal dominant condition caused by inactivating mutations in the calcium-sensing receptor gene leading to a higher set point for calcium-mediated PTH suppression. Presents with mild hypercalcemia, inappropriately normal or mildly elevated PTH, and low urinary calcium excretion with calcium-to-creatinine clearance ratio less than 0.01.

**Familial Mediterranean Fever**

An autosomal recessive autoinflammatory disorder (MEFV gene mutations, pyrin/inflammasome dysregulation) causing recurrent self-limited febrile attacks with serositis (peritonitis, pleuritis, synovitis), erysipelas-like erythema, lasting 12-72 hours.

**Familial Multiple Lipomatosis**

An autosomal dominant condition characterized by the development of numerous, symmetrically distributed subcutaneous lipomas, typically appearing in early adulthood. The lipomas are encapsulated, painless, and slow-growing, affecting the trunk and extremities. Unlike Dercum disease, they are not painful.

**Familial Multiple Trichoepithelioma**

An inherited disorder characterized by multiple benign hair-follicle tumors, usually skin-coloured papules on the face; it may be associated with pathogenic variants in *CYLD* and Brooke-Spiegler

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syndrome.

### **Family Involvement**

The participation of family members or other support persons in care planning, treatment, rehabilitation, and support, with attention to the patient's preferences and caregiver burden.

### **Fanconi Anemia**

An autosomal recessive (or X-linked) bone marrow failure syndrome caused by mutations in at least 22 FANC genes involved in DNA repair (the FA/BRCA pathway).

### **Fanconi Syndrome**

Generalized proximal tubular dysfunction with impaired reabsorption of glucose, amino acids, phosphate, uric acid, and bicarbonate. Causes glycosuria, aminoaciduria, phosphaturia, and metabolic acidosis. Associated with proximal RTA. Causes include myeloma, heavy metal toxicity, Wilson disease, and genetic disorders.

### **Farmer's Lung**

The most common HP, caused by thermophilic actinomyces in moldy hay. Presents acutely 4–8 hours after exposure with fever, cough, and dyspnea.

### **Farsightedness**

Hyperopia, a refractive error in which light focuses behind the retina, causing near blur or eyestrain; glasses or contact lenses can correct it.

#### **Synonyms:**

hyperopia, in which light focuses behind the retina when.

### **Fascial Loop**

A loop or sling made from a person's tissue or synthetic material and used to support or reinforce a body structure, such as the urethra.

### **Fasciitis**

Inflammation of fascia, the connective tissue surrounding muscles and other structures. Causes and severity vary widely, from localized plantar fasciitis

to serious infectious fasciitis.

### **Fascioliasis**

A parasitic infection caused by liver flukes of the genus *Fasciola*, acquired by ingesting metacercariae on contaminated aquatic plants or in water. Acute hepatic migration may cause fever, right-upper-quadrant pain, hepatomegaly, and eosinophilia; chronic biliary infection may cause colic, cholangitis, or biliary obstruction.

### **Fasciotomy**

Surgical incision through the fascia to relieve compartment syndrome. Indications: acute compartment syndrome (trauma, reperfusion, burns, crush injury). Classic signs: pain out of proportion, pain with passive stretch, paresthesias, pallor, pulselessness (late).

### **Fast Heart Rate**

A heart rate faster than expected for age or activity, usually called tachycardia. It may be a normal response to exercise, fever, pain, or stress, or a sign of arrhythmia or another medical disorder.

### **Fasting Guidelines**

Preoperative fasting guidelines minimize aspiration risk while reducing patient discomfort and catabolism. Clear liquids (water, clear juice without pulp, black coffee, sports drinks) are allowed up to 2 hours before surgery. Breast milk up to 4 hours. Infant formula up to 6 hours. Light meal (toast and clear liquid) up to 6 hours.

### **Fat Embolism**

Fat embolism occurs when fat globules enter the bloodstream, typically following long bone fractures, orthopedic surgery, or severe trauma involving adipose tissue.

### **Fat Necrosis**

A specialized form of necrosis that occurs in adipose tissue, most commonly following acute pancreatitis when activated pancreatic lipases escape into the surrounding tissues and digest triglycerides in mesenteric or subcutaneous fat cells. In the breast,

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it may follow trauma or surgery and can produce a firm lump that mimics malignancy on examination or imaging.

### **Fat-Soluble Toxins**

Lipophilic toxins stored in fat, prolonged elimination. Examples: organochlorine pesticides, PCBs, dioxins, tetrachlorodiphenylmethane.

### **Fatigue**

Fatigue is a persistent sense of low energy or reduced capacity that may result from sleep problems, anemia, infection, endocrine disease, medication, mood disorder, or systemic illness. relieved by rest. It may result from sleep disturbance, anemia, infection, endocrine disease, chronic organ disease, medication exposure, or psychological and neurological conditions.

### **Fatigue (Cancer)**

Persistent tiredness or reduced energy associated with cancer or its treatment. It may result from the disease, anemia, sleep problems, medicines, mood, or other factors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer

### **Fatty Acid**

A carboxylic acid with a hydrocarbon chain that may be saturated or contain one or more double bonds. Fatty acids provide energy, form membrane lipids, and serve as precursors for signaling molecules.

### **Fatty Acid Synthase**

Multi-enzyme complex for fatty acid synthesis. Produces palmitate.

### **Fatty Liver Disease**

A condition characterized by the accumulation of excess fat in liver cells, most commonly associated with obesity, insulin resistance, and metabolic syndrome.

### **Febrile**

Feverish; having a high body temperature.

### **Febrile Neutropenia**

Fever in a patient with a sufficiently low absolute neutrophil count to create a high risk of serious infection, generally defined as a single temperature of at least 38.3°C or sustained temperature of at least 38.0°C with ANC below 500/ $\mu$ L or expected to fall below that level.

### **Febrile Seizure**

A seizure occurring in a child usually between 6 months and 5 years of age with fever but without evidence of central nervous system infection or a previous afebrile seizure. Simple febrile seizures are generalized, brief, and nonrecurrent within the same illness; prolonged or focal events require further evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Seizure, Febrile

### **Fecal Calprotectin**

Neutrophil-derived protein measured in stool as a marker of intestinal inflammation. It is stable in stool at room temperature for up to seven days. Useful for differentiating inflammatory from functional bowel disease and monitoring inflammatory bowel disease activity.

### **Fecal Elastase**

Pancreatic enzyme measured in stool as a marker of exocrine pancreatic function. Low levels below two hundred micrograms per gram indicate pancreatic insufficiency, and levels below one hundred are consistent with severe exocrine insufficiency.

### **Fecal Immunochemical Test**

A stool-based screening test that uses antibodies to detect human hemoglobin. A positive result generally requires evaluation of the colon, commonly with colonoscopy. Test intervals and follow-up depend on screening guidance and clinical risk.



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## **Fecal Impaction**

A large, firm mass of stool retained in the rectum or colon that cannot be evacuated normally. It may cause abdominal or rectal pain, distention, overflow diarrhoea, urinary symptoms, nausea, or bowel obstruction and is associated with constipation, immobility, dehydration, neurological disease, and medications.

## **Fecal Incontinence**

Inability to control bowel movements ranging from minor soiling to complete loss of continence. Causes include sphincter injury from obstetric trauma or surgery, neuropathy from diabetes or spinal cord injury, diarrhea, rectal prolapse, and cognitive impairment.

### **Synonyms:**

Incontinence, Bowel Incontinence, Fecal

## **Fecal Microbiota Transplantation**

Transfer of processed stool from a screened donor into a patient's gastrointestinal tract to restore microbial diversity. It may be used for selected recurrent *Clostridioides difficile* infection when standard treatment has failed; careful donor screening and clinical supervision are required.

## **Fecundity**

The biological ability to conceive and produce a live birth. Fecundity is influenced by age (declines significantly after 35), ovarian reserve, tubal patency, uterine factors, and male fertility (sperm count, motility, morphology). Fecundability: the probability of achieving pregnancy in a single menstrual cycle.

## **Feedback Inhibition**

Regulatory mechanism where the end product of a metabolic pathway inhibits an earlier enzyme (usually the first committed step). Examples: isoleucine inhibiting threonine deaminase, CTP inhibiting aspartate transcarbamoylase, ATP inhibiting phosphofructokinase. Allows efficient resource utilization and prevents overproduction.

## **Feeding Jejunostomy**

Surgical or endoscopic placement of a feeding tube into the jejunum for enteral nutrition when upper gastrointestinal access is not feasible. Used in patients with head and neck cancers, esophageal obstruction, or severe dysphagia. Provides long-term nutritional support and avoids the complications of parenteral nutrition.

## **Feeding Tube**

A flexible tube used to deliver nutrition, fluids, or medicines to the stomach or intestine when oral intake is inadequate or unsafe.

## **Felty Syndrome**

Triad of rheumatoid arthritis, splenomegaly, and neutropenia (ANC <2000). Complication of long-standing, severe, seropositive RA. Increased infection risk. Treatment: DMARDs (methotrexate, TNF inhibitors), G-CSF for neutropenia, splenectomy in refractory cases.

## **Female Genital Mutilation**

FGM: the partial or total removal of female external genitalia for non-medical reasons, a human rights violation practiced in parts of Africa, the Middle East, and Asia (types I-IV). Immediate complications: severe pain, hemorrhage, infection, urinary retention.

## **Female Infertility**

Failure to achieve pregnancy after a defined period of regular unprotected intercourse, due to factors involving ovulation, the reproductive tract, ovarian reserve, or other causes.

### **Synonyms:**

Infertility, Female

## **Female Orgasmic Disorder (Anorgasmia)**

Persistent or recurrent delay in, infrequency of, or absence of orgasm that causes personal distress. It may be lifelong or acquired and can have medical, psychological, relationship, medication-related, or other causes.

### **Synonyms:**

Anorgasmia

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## Female Sexual Interest/Arousal Disorder

Persistent or recurrent reduction in sexual interest, thoughts, responsiveness, or arousal that causes personal distress. Causes may include medical conditions, medicines, mood, relationship factors, pain, or other psychological and social factors.

## Femoral Artery

Continues from external iliac through the femoral triangle and adductor canal to become the popliteal artery. Branches: superficial/deep circumflex femoral, deep femoral (profunda femoris), muscular. Palpable in the femoral triangle; most common site for arterial catheterization. Related to femoral vein medially and nerve laterally.

## Femoral Hernia

A hernia in which abdominal contents pass through the femoral ring into the femoral canal, below the inguinal ligament and medial to the femoral vessels. It may become incarcerated or strangulated and often requires surgical assessment.

## Femoral Nerve

Largest lumbar plexus nerve (L2-L4), passing through psoas major and entering the thigh under the inguinal ligament lateral to the femoral artery. Innervates quadriceps, sartorius, pectineus; sensation to anterior thigh and medial leg (saphenous nerve). Used for knee surgery nerve block anesthesia.

## Femoral Shaft Fractures

Femoral shaft fractures: high energy (MVC, fall from height) or low energy (elderly, pathologic). Winquist-Hansen classification of comminution: I (none), II (butterfly <50% width), III (butterfly >50%), IV (segmental).

## Femoral Triangle

Upper anterior thigh space bounded superiorly by the inguinal ligament, laterally by sartorius, and medially by adductor longus. Contents from lateral to medial: femoral nerve, artery, vein, and deep inguinal lymph nodes. The femoral artery is used for arterial catheterization. The femoral vein is

accessed for central venous lines.

## Femoral Vein

The major deep vein of the thigh, continuation of the popliteal vein (through the adductor hiatus), running with the femoral artery in the femoral sheath (medial to artery) through the femoral triangle, becoming the external iliac vein at the inguinal ligament. Receives the great saphenous vein.

## Femur

Longest, heaviest, strongest body bone. Proximal: head, neck, trochanters. Shaft: linea aspera. Distal: condyles, epicondyles. The neck connects head to shaft at approximately 125 degrees.

## Femur Length

The length of the fetal femur (diaphysis), measured from the greater trochanter to the distal femoral metaphysis. Used for dating (14-26 weeks) and growth assessment. Normal growth: 2 mm per week. Short femur: can be constitutional (especially with short parents), associated with aneuploidy (trisomy 21, skeletal dysplasias), or IUGR.

## Fencer's Pose

The posture produced by the asymmetric tonic neck reflex, with extension of the arm and leg on the side toward which the head is turned and flexion on the opposite side.

## FeNO (Fractional Exhaled Nitric Oxide)

A breath test that estimates type 2, often eosinophilic, airway inflammation. The result is interpreted with symptoms, age, treatment, and other clinical findings.

### Synonyms:

Fractional Exhaled Nitric Oxide

## Fenofibrate

A fibric acid derivative (fibrate) activating PPAR-alpha, increasing HDL and reducing triglycerides, with modest LDL effects. Used for severe hypertriglyceridemia (pancreatitis risk), mixed dyslipidemia, and as an adjunct in residual hypertriglyceridemia.

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## Fentanyl Derivatives

Potent synthetic opioids related to fentanyl that may be used for analgesia or anesthesia. Examples include sufentanil, remifentanil, and alfentanil; their potency, duration, dosing, and risks differ, and they require careful monitoring because they can depress breathing.

## Ferritin

Intracellular iron storage protein reflecting total body iron stores. Low ferritin: iron deficiency anemia (<30 ng/mL, absolute; <100 can be consistent with iron deficiency in inflammation).

## Fertilisation

The union of a sperm and an egg (oocyte) to form a zygote, the first cell of a new individual.

## Fertility

The biological capacity to conceive and produce offspring. Fertility depends on the proper functioning of the reproductive system in both males and females, including ovulation, sperm production, and hormonal regulation.

## Fertility Preservation

Measures taken before gonadotoxic cancer therapy to preserve reproductive potential, including embryo or oocyte cryopreservation, sperm banking, and ovarian or testicular tissue cryopreservation.

## FESS

Functional endoscopic sinus surgery is a minimally invasive surgical technique that uses nasal endoscopes and specialized instruments to restore normal sinus drainage and ventilation by removing obstructive tissue and opening blocked sinus ostia, while preserving as much normal sinus mucosa and anatomy as possible.

## Fetal Acid-Base Status

Assessment of fetal oxygenation and acid-base balance, usually using umbilical cord blood gases at birth or other intrapartum information. Interpretation depends on the complete gas panel, sampling site, timing, clinical condition, and laboratory refer-

ence ranges; marked acidemia may indicate impaired oxygenation.

## Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder

A broad spectrum of physical, behavioral, and cognitive impairments caused by prenatal alcohol exposure.

### Synonyms:

Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders

## Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders

Alternate index label; see *Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder*.

## Fetal Alcohol Syndrome

A collection of birth defects resulting from exposure of the fetus to alcohol during pregnancy, representing the most severe form of fetal alcohol spectrum disorder (FASD).

## Fetal Attitude

The relationship of the fetal body parts to one another, especially the degree of flexion or extension of the head and limbs. The usual attitude is flexion, but deflexed, neutral, or extended attitudes can affect the presenting part and labor.

## Fetal Bradycardia

A fetal heart-rate baseline below 110 beats per minute for at least 10 minutes. Causes include medicines, maternal conditions, fetal conduction disease, hypoxia, cord problems, or placental abruption; persistent or severe bradycardia requires urgent obstetric assessment.

## Fetal Distress

Abnormal fetal status during labor, indicated by abnormal fetal heart rate patterns (late or prolonged decelerations, minimal variability, absent accelerations). May indicate fetal hypoxia, cord compression, or placental insufficiency.

## Fetal Echocardiography

A specialized ultrasound examination of the fetal heart used to assess cardiac structure, rhythm, and

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function, including possible congenital heart disease.

### **Fetal Growth Restriction**

Failure of a fetus to reach its biologic growth potential, often associated with placental insufficiency. It is assessed using serial growth measurements, amniotic fluid, Doppler studies, and fetal surveillance rather than a single estimated-weight threshold alone.

### **Fetal Heart Rate**

Normal fetal heart rate ranges from 110-160 beats per minute. Monitored via auscultation with a fetoscope, Doppler ultrasound, or continuous electronic fetal monitoring. Baseline FHR is determined over a 10-minute window and is modulated by the autonomic nervous system.

### **Fetal Hydrops**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in at least two fetal compartments, such as the skin, chest, abdomen, or around the heart. Causes include fetal anemia, heart disease, infection, chromosome conditions, and immune incompatibility; it requires specialist obstetric evaluation.

### **Fetal Hypoxia**

Inadequate oxygen available to the fetus before or during birth. It may result from placental problems, reduced maternal oxygenation, cord compression, or prolonged labor. Abnormal fetal heart-rate patterns can indicate risk and require prompt obstetric assessment.

### **Fetal Kick Counts (Fetal Movement Counting)**

Observation and recording of fetal movements by a pregnant person. A noticeable reduction from the usual pattern should prompt timely obstetric advice.

#### **Synonyms:**

Fetal Movement Counting

### **Fetal Lie**

The relationship between the long axis of the fetus and that of the pregnant person. It may be longitu-

dinal, transverse, or oblique. A persistent abnormal lie near delivery can affect the mode of birth.

### **Fetal Macrosomia**

Excessive fetal size, often defined as estimated or birth weight of at least 4,000 or 4,500 g depending on the clinical context. Diabetes, excessive maternal weight gain, and prior macrosomia are risk factors; complications include shoulder dystocia, birth trauma, and cesarean delivery.

### **Fetal Presentation**

The fetal part that enters the maternal pelvis first. Presentations include cephalic, breech, shoulder, face, brow, and compound forms; the presentation influences labor and delivery planning.

### **Fetal Scalp Electrode**

A spiral wire electrode placed on the fetal scalp through the cervix to directly record the fetal heart rate. Provides a more accurate FHR signal than external Doppler, particularly in obese patients or when external monitoring is inadequate. Indications: poor-quality external tracing, need for internal monitoring.

### **Fetal Scalp Stimulation**

A bedside test during labor in which the fetal scalp is gently stimulated during a vaginal examination. A resulting fetal heart-rate acceleration may be reassuring, but the result must be interpreted with the complete fetal monitoring pattern and clinical context.

### **Fetal Tachycardia**

A sustained fetal heart-rate baseline above 160 beats per minute for at least 10 minutes. Causes may include maternal fever, infection, medicines, fetal hypoxia, or fetal arrhythmia.

### **Fetal Ultrasound**

Ultrasound imaging during pregnancy. First trimester (6-12 weeks): confirm pregnancy, gestational age (crown-rump length), number of fetuses, viability (heart activity), nuchal translucency (screening for aneuploidy at 11-13 weeks).

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## Fetal Viability

The potential for a fetus to survive outside the uterus with medical support. It depends on gestational age, fetal condition, available neonatal care, and other clinical factors; it is not a single fixed point.

## Fetishistic Disorder

A paraphilic disorder characterized by recurrent, intense sexual arousal from either the use of nonliving objects (fetish) or a highly specific focus on nongenital body parts (partialism), lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing distress or impairment or involving acting on these urges.

## Fetomaternal Hemorrhage

Transplacental passage of fetal red blood cells into the maternal circulation. Occurs in small amounts during normal pregnancy but can be massive during trauma, placental abruption, or cesarean delivery.

## Fetus

An unborn offspring from the 9th week of gestation (after the embryonic period) until birth. The fetal period is characterized by rapid growth, maturation of organ systems, and increasing complexity of function.

## FEV1/FVC Ratio

Fraction of air exhaled in first second relative to total.  $< 0.70$  post-bronchodilator indicates obstruction. Normal or elevated in restrictive disease.

## Fever

Fever is a regulated rise in body temperature caused by altered hypothalamic set point, commonly in response to infection or inflammation; age, duration, and associated signs determine concern.

## Fever, Acute, In Adults

A fever in an adult with recent onset, commonly caused by infection, inflammation, medication, heat illness, or other conditions. Severity, vital signs, immune status, source, and associated symptoms guide evaluation; confusion, breathing difficulty, stiff neck, shock, or severe localized pain requires urgent

care.

## Fever, Chronic (FUO)

A prolonged or recurrent fever that remains unexplained after initial evaluation; fever of unknown origin is traditionally defined as a temperature of at least 101 degrees Fahrenheit (38.3 degrees Celsius) on several occasions lasting more than three weeks without a diagnosis after appropriate assessment. Causes include infection, malignancy, inflammatory disease, and medications. duration, height, and patient factors. Common causes: infections (bacterial, viral), autoimmune disorders, malignancies, drug reactions. Management: antipyretics (acetaminophen, ibuprofen), treat underlying cause.

## Fever Of Unknown Origin

Persistent or recurrent fever for which an appropriate initial evaluation has not established a diagnosis.

## Fexofenadine

A second-generation (non-sedating) H1 antihistamine used for allergic rhinitis and chronic urticaria. Peripherally selective with minimal sedation and anticholinergic effects; no significant CNS penetration. Adverse effects: headache, dizziness, and dry mouth.

## Fiber

Dietary fiber is nondigestible carbohydrate and plant material that reaches the colon; soluble and insoluble fiber affect stool bulk, bowel transit, glycaemic control, and blood lipids. cholesterol, blood glucose. Insoluble (whole grains, vegetables) adds bulk, prevents constipation. Recommended: 25-30 g/day.

## Fiber Optic

A technology that transmits light through flexible glass or plastic fibers. It is used in medical endoscopes and other imaging or examination devices.

## Fibrin Sealant

A biological adhesive containing fibrinogen and thrombin that forms a fibrin clot when applied to tissue. It may help control bleeding or seal selected



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surgical surfaces.

### **Fibrinogen**

A soluble plasma protein, also called coagulation factor I, that is converted to fibrin during blood clot formation. Its concentration may increase with inflammation and decrease with severe liver disease or consumption coagulopathy.

#### **Synonyms:**

coagulation factor I, that is converted to fibrin during blood clot formation.

### **Fibrinolytic Therapy**

Treatment with medications that dissolve blood clots by activating plasminogen to plasmin, which breaks down fibrin. Common agents include tissue plasminogen activator (tPA), streptokinase, and urokinase. Used for acute ischemic stroke, pulmonary embolism, and myocardial infarction. Risks include bleeding complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Thrombolytic therapy

### **Fibrinoid Necrosis**

A specialized pattern of vascular necrosis characterized by the deposition of immune complexes, fibrin, and plasma proteins within the walls of blood vessels, creating an amorphous, bright pink, smudgy eosinophilic appearance on hematoxylin and eosin staining.

### **Fibrinolysis**

The enzymatic breakdown of fibrin within a blood clot, principally mediated by plasmin generated from plasminogen. It limits clot extension and supports restoration of vascular patency; excessive fibrinolysis can cause bleeding, whereas impaired fibrinolysis can promote thrombosis.

### **Fibrinous Pericarditis**

Inflammation of the pericardium characterized by deposition of fibrin on the pericardial surfaces, giving them a rough, shaggy appearance described as bread-and-butter pericarditis.

### **Fibroadenoma**

The most common benign tumor of the female breast, a proliferation of stromal and epithelial elements presenting as a firm, rubbery, smooth, mobile, painless mass, most often in women aged fifteen to thirty. The mass slips easily under the fingers (breast mouse), and ultrasonography shows a well-defined oval hypoechoic lesion.

### **Fibrocartilage**

Strong cartilage containing dense bundles of type I collagen, adapted to resist compression and tension. It forms intervertebral discs, the pubic symphysis, and menisci.

### **Fibrocystic Breast Changes**

A benign condition characterized by lumpy, painful breast tissue, most common in women aged 20-50, driven by hormonal fluctuations during the menstrual cycle (estrogen and progesterone). Microscopic features include stromal fibrosis, cyst formation (macrocyts and microcyts), and adenosis (increased glandular tissue).

### **Fibrocystic Breasts**

Benign breast changes involving fibrosis and cyst formation, often producing lumpy or tender breasts that fluctuate with the menstrual cycle. They are common and are not themselves a premalignant condition.

### **Fibroids, Cysts, And Polyps**

Benign growths that can develop in the reproductive organs. Fibroids are smooth muscle tumors of the uterus; cysts are fluid-filled sacs that commonly form on the ovaries; and polyps are tissue overgrowths in the endometrium or cervix.

### **Fibroma**

A benign cardiac tumour composed of fibroblasts and collagen, usually arising within the ventricular myocardium or interventricular septum in children. It may cause ventricular obstruction or clinically important arrhythmias; echocardiography and cardiac MRI help define its location and extent.



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## **Fibromuscular Dysplasia**

A non-atherosclerotic, non-inflammatory disease of medium-sized arteries, often involving the renal or carotid arteries. Imaging may show alternating narrowing and dilation. Symptoms, vascular complications, and treatment depend on the arteries involved and the individual clinical situation.

## **Fibromyalgia**

Fibromyalgia is a chronic pain-amplification disorder with widespread pain, fatigue, unrefreshing sleep, and cognitive symptoms without a single defining tissue lesion. months), fatigue, sleep disturbance, cognitive dysfunction (fibro fog), and somatic symptoms, affecting 2-4% of population (female:male 9:1).

## **Fibrosarcoma**

A malignant tumor of fibroblasts, a soft tissue sarcoma of adulthood or infancy, arising in deep soft tissues, bones, or paranasal sinuses.

## **FibroScan**

Non-invasive transient elastography technique measuring liver stiffness to assess hepatic fibrosis. Values correlate with fibrosis stage with higher values indicating more advanced fibrosis. The technique avoids the need for liver biopsy in many patients. Results may be unreliable in obesity, ascites, and narrow intercostal spaces.

## **Fibrosing Alopecia**

A group of primary cicatricial (scarring) alopecias in which chronic inflammation leads to permanent destruction of hair follicles and replacement by fibrous tract remnants. It includes conditions such as lichen planopilaris, frontal fibrosing alopecia, and central centrifugal cicatricial alopecia.

## **Fibrosis**

The excessive deposition of extracellular matrix components, primarily collagen types I and III, in response to chronic tissue injury. It represents a pathological wound healing response that leads to organ scarring and dysfunction.

## **Fibrous Dysplasia**

A benign skeletal disorder in which normal bone is replaced by fibro-osseous tissue, producing weakened or misshapen bone. It may affect one bone or multiple bones and can cause pain, deformity, pathological fracture, or nerve compression; imaging often shows a characteristic ground-glass appearance.

## **Fibula**

Slender lateral leg bone, not weight-bearing, serving for muscle attachment and forming the lateral malleolus. Head provides biceps femoris and lateral collateral ligament attachment; the common peroneal nerve wraps around its neck, vulnerable to injury. Lateral malleolus extends more distally and posteriorly than the medial malleolus.

## **Field Of View**

The extent of anatomy or space captured in one image or measurement.

## **Fifth Disease**

Erythema infectiosum caused by Parvovirus B19. Characterized by bright red cheeks (slapped cheek appearance) followed by a lacy, reticulated rash on the trunk and extremities. Mild febrile illness in children. Concern in pregnancy (hydrops fetalis risk) and immunocompromised patients (pure red cell aplasia). Diagnosis by serology.

### **Synonyms:**

Erythema Infectiosum (Fifth Disease)

## **Filariasis**

A group of tissue-dwelling nematode infections transmitted by mosquitoes, blackflies, deerflies, or other vectors. Lymphatic filariasis is caused mainly by *Wuchereria bancrofti*, *Brugia malayi*, and *Brugia timori*; adult worms in lymphatic vessels can cause recurrent inflammation, lymphedema, hydrocele, and elephantiasis. Other filarial species cause skin, eye, or subcutaneous disease, so diagnosis and treatment depend on the species and anatomic site.

## **Filoviruses**

A family of negative-sense RNA viruses that includes Ebola and Marburg viruses. These viruses

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cause severe hemorrhagic fever with high mortality rates. The virus is transmitted through contact with infected body fluids. The incubation period is 2-21 days. Symptoms include fever, headache, myalgia, and hemorrhage.

### **Filter (Vascular)**

A device placed in a large vein, usually the inferior vena cava, to trap clots and reduce the risk of pulmonary embolism in selected patients.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Filtered Back Projection**

An image-reconstruction method that mathematically back-projects measured data after applying a filter. It is fast but can be more sensitive to noise and artifacts than iterative methods.

### **Filtration Fraction**

The fraction of renal plasma flow that is filtered at the glomerulus, calculated as GFR divided by renal plasma flow (RPF). Normal GFR is approximately 125 mL/min and RPF is approximately 625 mL/min, yielding a filtration fraction of approximately 0.20 (20 percent).

### **Fimbriae**

The finger-like projections at the distal end of each fallopian tube that sweep over the ovary during ovulation to capture the released egg and guide it into the fallopian tube. The fimbriae are lined with ciliated epithelium that creates a current to draw the egg into the tube.

### **Fine Crackles**

High-pitched, brief, discontinuous sounds heard at the end of inspiration, caused by opening of small airways. They are characteristic of ILD, pulmonary fibrosis, and heart failure. They are also called Velcro crackles due to their resemblance to the sound of Velcro being pulled apart.

#### **Synonyms:**

Velcro crackles due to their resemblance to the sound of.

### **Fine Motor Skills**

The ability to use small muscles (hands/fingers) for precise movements, developing with age: reaching (3-4 months), grasping (5-6 months), pincer grasp (9-12 months), self-feeding (12-18 months), building towers/scribbling (18-24 months), drawing shapes and using utensils (3-5 years), and handwriting.

### **Fine Needle Aspiration**

A percutaneous sampling technique in which a 22 to 25-gauge needle, often ultrasound- or palpation-guided, aspirates cellular material from a palpable or imaging-detected lesion for cytologic examination, with minimal trauma and lower morbidity than core or open biopsy.

### **Finger Dislocation**

Displacement of the bones forming a finger joint, usually caused by a direct blow, fall, or forced bending. Pain, swelling, deformity, and loss of movement are typical. The joint should be assessed for fracture, tendon injury, and neurovascular compromise before reduction and splinting.

### **Finkelstein Test**

A wrist examination that stresses the tendons on the thumb side of the wrist. Pain near the radial styloid may support a diagnosis of de Quervain tenosynovitis but is not specific by itself.

### **First Stage Of Labor**

The period from the onset of regular labor to complete cervical dilation. It includes a latent phase and an active phase, with progress varying widely among individuals. Assessment considers cervical change, contraction pattern, maternal and fetal condition, and the overall clinical course.

### **First Trimester**

The period from conception to 12 weeks gestational age. Characterized by rapid embryonic organogenesis, rising hCG levels, and establishment of the placenta. Common symptoms include nausea, vomiting, fatigue, and breast tenderness. Dating ultrasound performed to confirm gestational age. Risk of miscarriage highest during this trimester.

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### First-Degree AV Block

A conduction delay in which every atrial impulse reaches the ventricles but with a prolonged PR interval ( $>0.20$  seconds). It is caused by delayed conduction through the AV node or His-Purkinje system. First-degree block is usually benign and asymptomatic.

### First-Degree Burn

A superficial burn affecting only the epidermis: erythema, pain, and dryness without blistering (e.g., mild sunburn); heals in 3-7 days without scarring. Assessment: size (percent BSA—rule of nines), depth, and cause (thermal, chemical, electrical).

### First-Episode Psychosis

The first clinically recognized episode of psychosis, regardless of eventual diagnosis. It requires urgent assessment for substance exposure, medication effects, mood symptoms, neurologic disease, systemic illness, safety risk, and functional decline.

### First-Pass Effect

The metabolism of a drug by the liver and intestinal wall before it reaches the systemic circulation after oral administration.

### First-Pass Metabolism

The metabolism of a drug by the liver before it reaches systemic circulation after oral administration. Drugs with high first-pass metabolism (e.g., morphine, nitroglycerin, lidocaine) have low oral bioavailability and may require alternative routes (sublingual, transdermal, IV).

### FISH (Fluorescence In Situ Hybridization)

A molecular cytogenetic technique using fluorescent DNA probes that hybridize to specific chromosomal regions. Faster than karyotype (24-48 hours, vs. 7-14 days).

#### Synonyms:

Fluorescence In Situ Hybridization

### Fissured Tongue

A usually harmless condition in which grooves or cracks develop on the surface of the tongue. Food and debris may collect in the fissures, causing irritation or odor. Gentle brushing of the tongue and routine oral care help prevent symptoms.

### Fistula

A fistula is an abnormal connection between two epithelialized surfaces, such as bowel and skin or two organs, caused by inflammation, infection, surgery, trauma, or congenital development. congenital development.

### Fistula (Pathology)

An abnormal epithelial-lined connection between two body surfaces or organs that normally do not communicate. Fistulas may be congenital, such as tracheoesophageal fistula, or acquired, resulting from inflammation, infection, surgery, trauma, or malignancy.

#### Synonyms:

Pathology

### Fistula-In-Ano

Abnormal epithelialized tract connecting the anal canal to the perianal skin, representing a common and distressing complication of Crohn disease and also occurring following perianal abscess drainage or from cryptoglandular infection.

### Fitz-Hugh-Curtis Syndrome

Perihepatitis associated with pelvic inflammatory disease caused by ascension of *Neisseria gonorrhoeae* or *Chlamydia trachomatis* from the pelvis to the liver capsule along the right paracolic gutter. Presents with right upper quadrant pain, fever, and tender hepatomegaly often in young sexually active women.

### Five-Year Survival Rate

The proportion of patients alive five years after diagnosis or treatment; a standard benchmark for comparing cancer outcomes.

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### **Fixed Drug Eruption**

A recurrent drug reaction appearing at the same site with each exposure to the offending drug. It presents as well-demarcated, round to oval, erythematous to violaceous plaques that may blister. Common culprits include sulfonamides, tetracyclines, NSAIDs, and barbiturates.

### **Flail Chest**

A clinical condition caused by three or more consecutive ribs fractured in two or more places, creating a free-floating segment of chest wall. The segment moves paradoxically inward during inspiration and outward during expiration. It causes severe pain, impaired ventilation, and may require mechanical ventilation.

### **Flakka**

A street name for synthetic cathinone stimulants, particularly alpha-PVP. Intoxication may cause extreme agitation, paranoia, hallucinations, seizures, dangerous hyperthermia, muscle breakdown, and cardiovascular instability. Severe agitation, altered consciousness, high temperature, or chest pain is a medical emergency.

### **Flank Pain**

Pain arising from the lateral back between the ribs and iliac crest, often reflecting disease of the kidney, ureter, musculoskeletal structures, or adjacent abdominal organs. Associated fever, haematuria, vomiting, urinary symptoms, trauma, or hypotension helps distinguish infection, obstruction, stones, injury, and other causes.

### **Flashes**

Perception of flickering light or lightning-like streaks from mechanoelectrical stimulation of the retina rather than an external source. The leading cause is posterior vitreous detachment, often with floaters; retinal tears and detachment, migraine aura, and optic neuritis also produce flashes.

### **Flat Feet**

Reduction or absence of the medial longitudinal arch, causing the sole to approach or contact the

ground during standing. Flexible flat feet are common and often asymptomatic; rigid or painful flat feet may result from structural deformity, tendon dysfunction, or arthritis.

### **Flatfoot**

A reduction or collapse of the medial longitudinal arch of the foot, with increased contact of the sole with the ground. It may be flexible and asymptomatic or rigid and painful; causes include normal development, ligamentous laxity, tendon dysfunction, trauma, inflammatory disease, and structural deformity.

### **Flatulence**

Passage of intestinal gas through the anus. It reflects swallowed air and bacterial fermentation of undigested carbohydrates and may be increased by dietary factors, constipation, malabsorption, altered gut motility, or functional gastrointestinal disorders; persistent symptoms require assessment for associated disease.

### **Flecainide**

A class IC sodium channel blocker that slows conduction velocity with little effect on refractoriness. Used for suppression of supraventricular arrhythmias (atrial fibrillation in patients without structural heart disease—'pill-in-the-pocket', paroxysmal SVT) and ventricular arrhythmias.

### **Flexibility**

The range through which a joint or group of joints can move, influenced by muscles, tendons, ligaments, joint structure, and pain.

### **Flexible Nasolaryngoscopy**

Office examination of the nasal cavity, nasopharynx, pharynx, and larynx using a flexible fiberoptic or digital endoscope passed through the nose. It evaluates voice change, swallowing symptoms, nasal obstruction, lesions, vocal-fold movement, and airway anatomy.

### **Flexible Sigmoidoscopy**

Endoscopic examination of the rectum and sigmoid

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colon (up to 60 cm). Indications: colorectal cancer screening (q5-10 years, combined with FIT), evaluation of rectal bleeding, chronic diarrhea, and surveillance of known distal colonic disease (ulcerative colitis).

### **Flexion**

Movement that decreases the angle between two bones or bends a joint, generally in the sagittal plane.

### **Flexor Digitorum Profundus**

Deep anterior forearm muscle with ulnar and humeroulnar heads, inserting on distal phalanges bases of digits 2-5. Medial half (digits 4-5) innervated by ulnar nerve; lateral half (digits 2-3) by anterior interosseous nerve (C8-T1). Flexes DIP, PIP, MCP joints, and wrist.

### **Flexor Digitorum Superficialis**

Large anterior forearm muscle with humeroulnar, radial, and ulnar heads, inserting on middle phalanges of digits 2-5. Innervated by median nerve (C8-T1). Flexes PIP joints, MCP joints, and wrist. Important for median nerve function assessment. Tendons pass through carpal tunnel, susceptible to stenosing tenosynovitis (trigger finger).

### **Floaters**

Mobile spots, threads, cobwebs, or rings in the visual field caused by vitreous opacities casting shadows on the retina. Most arise from posterior vitreous detachment, an age-related separation of the vitreous gel from the retina; hemorrhage, vitritis, and asteroid hyalosis are other causes.

### **Floating Ribs**

Ribs 11-12 with short costal cartilages terminating in abdominal wall musculature, not articulating with the sternum or other ribs. Most mobile and least protected, susceptible to fracture from direct trauma. Fractures may injure underlying kidneys, requiring hematuria and flank tenderness assessment in trauma.

### **Flossing**

Cleaning between teeth with dental floss or another interdental device to remove plaque and food debris from areas a toothbrush may not reach.

### **Flow Cytometry**

A laboratory technique that measures physical and molecular characteristics of cells or particles as they pass through a laser beam. It is used for cell counting, immunophenotyping, diagnosis of some leukemias and lymphomas, and assessment of selected immune disorders.

### **Flow-Volume Loop**

Graphical representation of airflow during forced breathing. Obstructive: scooped expiratory limb. Restrictive: narrowed loop with preserved shape. Variable extrathoracic obstruction: flattening of inspiratory limb.

### **Flu**

Influenza is an acute respiratory infection caused by influenza viruses, producing fever, cough, myalgia, headache, and fatigue with potential pulmonary or systemic complications. fever, cough, sore throat, headache, muscle aches, and fatigue. Complications may include pneumonia and worsening of underlying medical conditions.

### **Fludeoxyglucose F-18**

Radiotracer used in PET imaging, analog of glucose labeled with fluorine-18. Taken up by cells via glucose transporters and phosphorylated by hexokinase, trapped intracellularly. Uptake reflects metabolic activity. Used for oncology (tumor detection, staging, response assessment), neurology (epilepsy, dementia), cardiology (viability).

### **Fluid Imbalance**

An abnormal excess or deficiency of body water or electrolytes such as sodium, potassium, calcium, or bicarbonate. It may result from dehydration, kidney or heart disease, endocrine disorders, gastrointestinal losses, or inappropriate fluid administration.



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## Fluid Overload

Excess total body fluid due to impaired renal sodium/water excretion or excessive intake, leading to edema, weight gain, hypertension, and pulmonary congestion. Causes: heart failure, renal failure (acute/chronic), nephrotic syndrome, cirrhosis, iatrogenic (IV fluids), and hypoalbuminemia.

## Fluid Therapy

The intravenous administration of fluids to restore or maintain hydration, electrolyte balance, and circulatory volume. Types include isotonic (normal saline, lactated Ringer's), hypotonic, and hypertonic solutions. Used for dehydration, shock, surgery, and electrolyte imbalances. Monitoring includes fluid balance, vital signs, and laboratory values.

### Synonyms:

Intravenous fluid therapy

## Fluorescein Angiography

An eye test in which fluorescein dye is injected into a vein and sequential photographs are taken of the retinal circulation. It helps identify leakage, blocked vessels, abnormal new vessels, and other retinal or choroidal abnormalities.

## Fluorescence In-Situ Hybridization

A targeted cytogenetic technique using fluorescent DNA probes to detect or localize specific chromosome sequences. It can identify selected aneuploidies, microdeletions, gene rearrangements, or amplifications but does not survey the entire genome.

## Fluoride

Mineral that strengthens tooth enamel and inhibits bacterial acid production. Sources: water fluoridation (0.7 ppm optimal), toothpaste, professional applications. Mechanism: incorporates into hydroxyapatite forming fluorapatite (more acid-resistant), promotes remineralization, inhibits bacterial enzymes.

## Fluoride Varnish

A concentrated fluoride preparation applied to teeth by a healthcare professional to help prevent or arrest dental caries. The frequency of application depends

on age and caries risk.

## Fluorine-18

PET radionuclide, half-life 110 minutes. Produced in cyclotron via  $O-18(p,n)F-18$  reaction. Used in FDG and other tracers. Requires on-site or nearby cyclotron due to short half-life.

## Fluoroquinolones

Broad-spectrum bactericidal antibiotics that inhibit bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV, enzymes essential for DNA replication, transcription, and repair. They are synthetic derivatives of nalidixic acid and include ciprofloxacin, levofloxacin, moxifloxacin, and others.

## Fluoroscopy

Real-time X-ray imaging used to visualize dynamic processes.

## Fluorosis

Enamel hypomineralization from excess fluoride during development. Mild: white spots. Severe: brown stains, pitting. Prevention: monitor fluoride intake in children.

## Fluorouracil Side Effect

Toxicity from the antimetabolite 5-fluorouracil causing mucositis, diarrhea, hand-foot syndrome, myelosuppression, and potential cardiotoxicity, requiring dose adjustment or discontinuation.

## Flushing

Transient reddening and warmth of the skin caused by increased cutaneous blood flow. It may result from heat, emotion, exertion, fever, alcohol, endocrine or neuroendocrine disease, mast-cell activation, medication exposure, or autonomic dysfunction; associated diarrhoea, wheeze, hypotension, or palpitations may indicate systemic disease.

## Flutter Valve

A handheld device combining PEP therapy with oscillations during exhalation. The oscillations create shear forces that loosen mucus from airway walls,



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while the PEP keeps airways open. It is used for airway clearance in bronchiectasis, CF, and COPD.

### **FNA**

A percutaneous sampling technique in which a 22 to 25-gauge needle, often ultrasound- or palpation-guided, aspirates cellular material from a palpable or imaging-detected lesion for cytologic examination, with minimal trauma and lower morbidity than core or open biopsy. See Fine Needle Aspiration (FNA).

### **Focal Nodular Hyperplasia**

Benign liver lesion with a characteristic central stellate scar visible on imaging. The lesion represents a hyperplastic response to a pre-existing vascular malformation rather than a true neoplasm. Associated with oral contraceptive use though it also occurs in men and children. No risk of hemorrhage or malignant transformation.

### **Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis**

The most common cause of nephrotic syndrome in African American adults and Hispanic populations. Associated with HIV infection (HIV-associated nephropathy), heroin use, sickle cell disease, massive obesity, interferon therapy, and renal hyperfiltration (solitary kidney).

### **Focal Seizure**

A seizure arising from networks limited to one cerebral hemisphere at onset. Awareness may be preserved or impaired, and motor, sensory, autonomic, cognitive, or emotional features depend on the involved region; a focal seizure may spread to become bilateral tonic-clonic.

### **Focal-Onset Seizure**

A seizure that begins within networks limited to one cerebral hemisphere. Awareness may be preserved or impaired, and motor, sensory, autonomic, cognitive, or emotional features reflect the involved cortical region; it may evolve to bilateral tonic-clonic activity.

### **FODMAP Diet**

Restriction of Fermentable Oligo-, Di-, Mono-

saccharides And Polyols. Used for IBS management. Low FODMAP diet followed by gradual reintroduction.

### **Folate Deficiency**

Folate (vitamin B9) deficiency causes megaloblastic anemia identical to B12 deficiency but without neurologic manifestations (except possible cognitive changes). Dietary sources: leafy greens, legumes, liver; daily requirement 400 mcg. Absorption in jejunum.

### **Folate-Deficiency Anemia**

A megaloblastic anemia caused by inadequate folate, impaired absorption, increased need, or certain medicines; blood testing identifies the cause and folate replacement treats deficiency.

### **Foley Catheter**

An indwelling urinary catheter held in the bladder by an inflatable balloon and connected to a drainage system.

### **Folic Acid Supplementation**

Use of folic acid before conception and during early pregnancy to reduce the risk of fetal neural-tube defects. The dose depends on individual risk and local clinical guidance; folate is also needed for DNA synthesis and red-cell production.

### **Follicle Stimulating Hormone**

FSH: a gonadotropin secreted by the anterior pituitary, regulating gonadal function. In females: stimulates ovarian follicle growth and estradiol production; LH surge triggers ovulation. In males: stimulates Sertoli cells and spermatogenesis. Controlled by GnRH and feedback (estrogen, inhibin).

### **Follicular Lymphoma**

An indolent B-cell non-Hodgkin lymphoma with a follicular growth pattern. Many cases have changes involving BCL2, but classification depends on tissue and molecular findings. It commonly causes painless lymph-node enlargement and may involve bone marrow or other sites.

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## **Follicular Thyroid Carcinoma**

Second most common thyroid carcinoma accounting for approximately ten percent of cases. Distinguished from follicular adenoma by capsular or vascular invasion on histological examination which cannot be determined by fine-needle aspiration. Metastasizes hematogenously to bone, lung, and liver.

## **Folliculitis**

Inflammation of a hair follicle, often caused by bacteria, yeast, friction, occlusion, or ingrown hairs, producing small itchy or tender bumps.

### **Synonyms:**

Barber's Itch

## **Follow-Up Recommendations**

Recommendations for further imaging or evaluation. Based on guidelines ( Fleischner Society for lung nodules).

## **Fomepizole**

An alcohol dehydrogenase inhibitor used as an antidote for toxic alcohol exposure, particularly methanol and ethylene glycol. It prevents formation of toxic metabolites and is used with supportive care and hemodialysis when indicated.

## **Fomite**

An inanimate object or surface capable of transmitting infectious agents (viruses, bacteria, fungi) between people (e.g., doorknobs, towels, medical equipment, toys, needles). Transmission occurs when contaminated fomites contact mucous membranes or skin, or are involved in procedures.

## **Fontanelle**

Soft membranous spaces between skull bones that allow brain growth and skull molding during delivery. Anterior fontanelle diamond-shaped, closes by 12-18 months. Posterior fontanelle triangular, closes by 2-3 months. Bulging fontanelle suggests increased intracranial pressure; sunken fontanelle indicates dehydration.

## **Food Allergy**

Immune-mediated reaction to food protein. IgE-mediated: anaphylaxis. Non-IgE: EoE, food protein-induced enterocolitis. Common allergens: milk, egg, peanut, tree nut, fish, shellfish, soy, wheat.

### **Synonyms:**

Allergy Food (Food Allergy)

## **Food Intolerance**

Adverse reaction not immune-mediated. Lactose intolerance, gluten sensitivity (non-celiac), histamine intolerance, FODMAP sensitivity. Diagnosis: elimination diet, challenge.

## **Food Poisoning**

Illness caused by consuming food contaminated with bacteria, viruses, parasites, or their toxins. Common pathogens include Salmonella, Escherichia coli, Listeria, and norovirus, with symptoms such as nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and fever.

## **Food-Borne Disease**

Illness caused by eating food or drinking water contaminated with infectious organisms, toxins, or harmful chemicals.

## **Food-Drug Interaction**

An alteration in drug absorption, metabolism, distribution, or effect caused by a food, beverage, nutrient, or supplement. Examples include vitamin K affecting warfarin response, grapefruit affecting selected CYP3A4 substrates, and calcium impairing absorption of some medicines.

## **Foodborne Illness**

Any illness resulting from the ingestion of contaminated food, encompassing infections and intoxications caused by pathogens, toxins, or chemical contaminants. It affects millions annually and poses particular risks to pregnant women, young children, older adults, and immunocompromised individuals.

## **Foot Drop**

Weakness or paralysis of ankle dorsiflexion causing

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the forefoot to drag or the patient to lift the knee abnormally while walking. Common causes include common peroneal nerve injury, L5 radiculopathy, motor-neuron disease, and peripheral neuropathy.

**Synonyms:**

Drop Foot

**Foot Pain**

Pain in the foot caused by injury, overuse, arthritis, nerve disease, infection, or circulation problems. Persistent pain, inability to bear weight, numbness, discoloration, fever, or an open wound requires medical assessment.

**Force Plates**

Instruments that measure forces exerted by the feet on the ground during standing or movement, helping assess gait, balance, symmetry, and loading.

**Forced Expiratory Volume**

The volume of air forcibly exhaled in a specified time during a maximal expiratory effort. FEV1 is the volume exhaled in the first second; normally at least 70-80 percent of the forced vital capacity (FEV1/FVC ratio).

**Forced Oscillation Technique**

Similar to impulse oscillometry, applying small pressure oscillations at various frequencies during tidal breathing to measure respiratory resistance and reactance. It provides information about airway mechanics without requiring forced expiratory maneuvers.

**Forced Vital Capacity**

Total air exhaled after maximal inspiration. Reduced in both obstructive and restrictive disease. In restrictive disease, FVC reduced with preserved ratio.

**Forceps**

Grasping instrument. Tissue forceps: with teeth. Dressing forceps: without teeth.

**Forceps (Obstetric)**

A paired instrument used in selected operative vaginal deliveries to assist delivery of the fetal head.

**Synonyms:**

Obstetric

**Forceps (Surgical)**

Handheld instruments used to grasp, hold, move, or manipulate tissue or medical materials during a procedure.

**Synonyms:**

Surgical

**Forceps (Vascular)**

A surgical instrument used to grasp, hold, or manipulate tissue, vessels, or medical materials.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

**Forceps Delivery**

Assisted vaginal delivery using forceps (curved blades applied to the fetal head) to expedite delivery for maternal or fetal indications (prolonged second stage, fetal distress, maternal exhaustion, medical conditions limiting pushing).

**Forceps-Assisted Delivery**

Operative vaginal delivery using forceps (two curved blades applied to the fetal head). Types: outlet (forceps applied at the introitus, fetal scalp visible), low (station  $\geq +2$ , not at outlet), midpelvic (station  $\geq +2$  but head above ischial spines), and rotational (forceps used to rotate from OP to OA).

**Fordyce's Angiokeratomas**

Benign vascular ectasias of the superficial dermal capillaries covered by an epidermal reaction, appearing as small, dark red to purple, asymptomatic papules on the scrotum, vulva, or oral mucosa. They are common, increase with age, and are clinically insignificant. They may bleed if traumatized.

**Foreign Body**

Any object lodged in body. Types: organic (wood, thorn), inorganic (metal, glass, plastic). Ra-

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diopaque vs. radiolucent. Removal: surgical, endoscopic, spontaneous passage.

### **Foreign Body Aspiration**

Inhalation of object into airway. Common in children (peanuts, coins, small toys). Signs: choking, coughing, stridor, wheezing, decreased breath sounds. Diagnosis: chest X-ray (may be negative), bronchoscopy.

### **Foreign Body Reaction**

Inflammation and immune response to material that remains in tissue, such as a splinter, suture, implant, or other medical device. It may cause a lump, redness, drainage, pain, or scarring; treatment depends on the material and whether infection is present.

### **Foreign-Body Aspiration**

Entry of an object into the larynx, trachea, or bronchi, most often in toddlers. Sudden cough, choking, unilateral wheeze, or focal air trapping may occur; complete airway obstruction is an immediate emergency and requires age-appropriate resuscitation.

### **Forensic Anthropology**

The application of physical-anthropology methods to legal investigations involving human remains, especially skeletal material. It can help establish whether remains are human, estimate biological characteristics, assess trauma, and support identification.

### **Forensic Entomology**

The study of insects and other arthropods in legal investigations, principally to estimate the postmortem interval (PMI) and to link suspects to scenes.

### **Forensic Evidence**

Physical, biological, documentary, or testimonial material gathered, preserved, and analyzed to establish facts in a legal investigation. Categories include biological evidence (blood, semen, hair), trace evidence (fibers, glass, gunshot residue), pattern evidence (fingerprints, toolmarks, bloodstain patterns), and digital evidence.

### **Forensic Examination**

Structured medicolegal evaluation of a living or deceased person, scene, or evidence to document findings relevant to a legal matter. Components include sexual assault examination with evidence collection, child abuse assessment, injury documentation, driving-impairment evaluation, and autopsy.

### **Forensic Medicine (Legal Medicine)**

Branch of medicine that applies medical, biological, and scientific knowledge to legal questions and the administration of justice.

**Synonyms:**

Legal Medicine

### **Forensic Odontology**

The application of dental science to legal investigations. It may support human identification by comparing dental records, radiographs, and distinctive dental anatomy and may assist in the assessment of dental injuries.

### **Forensic Pathology**

A branch of pathology that applies medical knowledge to legal questions, especially the cause and manner of death and the documentation of injuries. Forensic pathologists examine deaths that are sudden, unexpected, violent, or otherwise subject to legal investigation.

### **Forensic Psychiatry**

The medical specialty at the interface of psychiatry and the law. Core activities: competency to stand trial, criminal responsibility/insanity defense (mental state at time of offense), dangerousness/risk assessment, civil commitment, testamentary capacity, and personal injury claims.

### **Forensic Radiography**

The use of imaging (X-ray, CT, MRI, ultrasound) in forensic and medico-legal investigation.

### **Forensic Toxicology**

The analysis of drugs, poisons, and their metabolites in biological specimens (blood, urine, vitreous

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humor, hair, tissues) to determine their role in intoxication, poisoning, or death.

### **Forensic Toxicology Screen**

Laboratory analysis of biological specimens for drugs, alcohols, poisons, and their metabolites. A screening result is presumptive until confirmed and quantified by a validated method such as mass spectrometry, with interpretation based on specimen type, timing, therapeutic use, and postmortem changes.

### **Formaldehyde**

Preservative, industrial chemical. Irritant, carcinogen (nasopharyngeal cancer). Sensitizer. Use in fume hood, PPE required.

### **Formalin-Fixed Paraffin-Embedded Tissue**

Tissue preserved in formalin, processed, and embedded in paraffin wax for sectioning and microscopic examination. FFPE blocks support histology, immunohistochemistry, and many molecular tests but may contain fixation-related nucleic-acid or antigen alterations.

### **Formication**

A sensation that insects are crawling on or under the skin when none are present. It may occur with nerve disorders, menopause, substance withdrawal, medication effects, or psychiatric illness. Persistent or new symptoms should be medically evaluated.

### **Formula Feeding**

Alternative to breastfeeding using commercially prepared infant formula. Types include cow's milk-based, soy-based, hydrolyzed protein, and amino acid-based formulas. Iron-fortified formulas standard to prevent iron deficiency anemia. Preparation requires clean water and proper sterilization of bottles.

### **Fornix**

The conjunctival fornix is the redundant, dome-shaped fold of conjunctiva where the palpebral conjunctiva transitions to the bulbar conjunctiva, form-

ing a deep recess superiorly (superior fornix), inferiorly (inferior fornix), and medially and laterally (medial and lateral fornices).

### **Fortification**

Addition of nutrients to food. Examples: iodized salt, vitamin D milk, folic acid grains. Public health strategy for deficiency prevention.

### **Four-Dimensional Ultrasound**

Real-time 3D ultrasound. Used in obstetrics for fetal imaging.

### **Fournier Gangrene**

A rapidly progressive necrotizing infection of the perineum, external genitalia, or perianal region. It causes severe pain, swelling, fever, systemic toxicity, and tissue necrosis and requires immediate surgical debridement and broad-spectrum antimicrobial treatment.

### **Fourth-Degree Tear**

A severe perineal tear during childbirth that extends through the anal sphincter and into the rectal mucosa. It requires careful examination, repair, follow-up, and assessment for complications.

### **Fovea**

A tiny depression in the center of the retina that provides the sharpest and most detailed visual acuity.

### **Fovea Centralis**

Central macular pit (approximately 1.5 mm) with the highest cone density (approximately 200,000 per square millimeter) and no rods, providing the sharpest visual acuity and color vision. Avascular with overlying retinal layers displaced laterally for direct light access to cones.

### **Fractional Excretion Of Sodium**

The percentage of filtered sodium excreted in urine, calculated from serum and urine sodium and creatinine. It may help distinguish prerenal physiology from tubular injury, although diuretics, CKD, sepsis,

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and other conditions limit interpretation.

### **Fractional Excretion Of Urea (FEUrea)**

The percentage of filtered urea excreted in urine. It may be used as an adjunct when diuretics make FENa less interpretable, but it is also affected by catabolism, sepsis, gastrointestinal bleeding, and chronic kidney disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

FEUrea

### **Fractional Flow Reserve**

An invasive physiological measurement during coronary catheterization using a pressure wire to assess the hemodynamic significance of a coronary stenosis.  $FFR = Pa/Pd$  (aortic pressure / distal coronary pressure) during maximal hyperemia (adenosine).

### **Fractional IPV**

A reduced-dose schedule of inactivated polio vaccine used in the WHO and India Universal Immunization Schedule, where one-fifth of the standard intramuscular IPV dose (0.1 mL instead of 0.5 mL) is given by intradermal injection at each of two deltoid sites (total 0.2 mL per fractional dose), rather than the full 0.5 mL intramuscular dose.

### **Fracture**

A break in the continuity of bone, classified by location, pattern (transverse, oblique, spiral, comminuted), displacement, and whether the fracture communicates with the external environment (open vs. closed). Fracture healing occurs through inflammatory, reparative, and remodeling phases.

### **Fracture Displacement**

Loss of normal anatomic alignment between fracture fragments, described by translation, angulation, shortening, or rotation. The acceptable degree depends on the bone, joint involvement, patient age, and functional demands.

### **Fracture Liaison Service**

A coordinated program that identifies patients with fragility fractures, evaluates bone health and secondary causes, initiates fracture prevention, and

ensures follow-up to reduce recurrent fractures.

### **Fracture Of The Temporal Bone**

A break in the thin bones forming the skull base and ear structures, potentially injuring the facial nerve, carotid artery, or middle ear and presenting with hearing loss, vertigo, or cerebrospinal fluid leak.

### **Fracture Prevention**

Measures that reduce the risk of bone fracture, including assessment and treatment of osteoporosis, strength and balance exercise, fall prevention, and correction of relevant nutritional or medication-related risks.

### **Fracture-Fixation Device**

An implant such as a plate, screw, intramedullary nail, or external-fixation component used to stabilize a broken bone and maintain alignment during healing. Selection depends on fracture pattern, bone quality, and soft-tissue condition.

### **Fragile X Syndrome**

An inherited neurodevelopmental disorder caused by expansion of a CGG repeat in the FMR1 gene, leading to reduced gene expression. It may cause intellectual disability, characteristic physical features, and behavioral or autism-spectrum features.

### **FRAIL Scale**

A brief frailty screen assessing Fatigue, Resistance, Ambulation, Illnesses, and Loss of weight. It identifies risk of frailty but is not a substitute for a comprehensive geriatric assessment.

### **Frailty**

Clinical syndrome of decreased reserve and resilience to stressors. Components: unintentional weight loss, exhaustion, low physical activity, slow gait speed, weak grip strength. Identification: Fried phenotype, frailty index. Consequences: adverse outcomes (falls, hospitalization, mortality), polypharmacy, functional decline.



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### Frameshift Mutation

Insertion or deletion of nucleotides not in multiples of three, shifting reading frame. Usually produces nonfunctional protein. Examples: some cystic fibrosis mutations, Tay-Sachs disease.

### Francisella Tularensis

A gram-negative coccobacillus that causes tularemia, a zoonotic infection transmitted by ticks, deer flies, or direct contact with infected animals. The organism can be acquired through the skin, respiratory tract, or gastrointestinal tract. Ulceroglandular tularemia presents with skin ulcer and regional lymphadenopathy.

### Frank-Starling Mechanism

The physiological principle stating that stroke volume increases as end-diastolic volume (preload) increases, up to an optimal point. Within physiological limits, greater ventricular stretch leads to stronger contraction due to increased calcium sensitivity of myofilaments and optimal overlap of actin and myosin.

### Free Radical

A molecule or atom containing an unpaired electron, making it chemically reactive. Excessive free-radical activity can contribute to oxidative injury.

### Free Radical Injury

Free radicals are highly reactive molecules with unpaired electrons that can damage cellular components through oxidative stress. Reactive oxygen species include the superoxide anion, hydrogen peroxide, and the hydroxyl radical generated through the Fenton reaction.

### Free Water Clearance

The rate at which the kidneys excrete water in excess of or less than the amount needed to produce urine isotonic to plasma. Positive clearance indicates excretion of dilute urine; negative clearance indicates retention of water through concentration of urine.

### Frenectomy

Surgical removal or repositioning of frenulum. Indications: diastema, gingival recession, tongue-tie, interference with denture.

### Frenulum Breve

An abnormally short penile frenulum that may cause pain, tearing, or bleeding during erection or sexual activity. Treatment depends on symptoms and may include observation or a minor surgical procedure.

### Frequency

Increased daytime micturition, typically more than seven episodes per day, distinguished from polyuria (high urine volume) and nocturia (nighttime voiding). Common causes include urinary tract infection, benign prostatic hyperplasia, overactive bladder, and diabetes mellitus.

### Frey's Syndrome

Aberrant regeneration of parasympathetic nerve fibers to sweat glands after injury to the auriculotemporal nerve, most commonly following parotid surgery or trauma. It results in gustatory sweating and facial flushing while eating. Diagnosis is confirmed by the starch-iodine test.

### Friedman Curve

The classic labor curve described by Emanuel Friedman in the 1950s, plotting cervical dilatation against time. Defined the latent and active phases, with active phase beginning at 4 cm. The Friedman curve was the standard for labor management for decades.

### Friedreich Ataxia

An inherited neurodegenerative disorder causing progressive gait and limb ataxia, sensory loss, weakness, and sometimes cardiomyopathy or diabetes.

### Frontal Bone

Forms the forehead and superior orbits, with the squama frontalis, orbital plates, and nasal part. Contains frontal sinuses draining into the nasal cavity via the frontonasal duct. Articulates with parietal bones at the coronal suture. The metopic suture fuses by age six.

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## Frontal Lobe

The largest lobe of the cerebral cortex, lying anterior to the central sulcus, comprising the primary motor cortex (precentral gyrus, Brodmann 4), premotor and supplementary motor areas, prefrontal cortex, and Broca's area (dominant hemisphere, expressive language).

## Frontal Sinus

The frontal sinuses are paired, air-filled cavities located within the frontal bone above the orbits and the root of the nose, separated by a bony septum that may be deviated to one side, and they are the last of the paranasal sinuses to develop, typically appearing around age seven and reaching full size by late adolescence.

## Frontal Sinusitis

Inflammation or infection of the frontal sinuses, causing forehead pain or pressure, nasal congestion, and drainage. Severe headache, swelling around the eye, high fever, confusion, or neurologic symptoms may indicate a complication requiring urgent care.

## Frontotemporal Dementia

Dementia affecting frontal and temporal lobes. Behavioral variant (personality changes) or language variant (aphasia). Younger onset (50-60).

### Synonyms:

Dementia, Frontotemporal

## Frostbite

Frostbite is freezing injury to tissue, causing numbness, pallor, waxy skin, blistering, and possible tissue necrosis; rewarming and assessment are urgent. degree (superficial, numbness, erythema), second degree (blisters, clear fluid, pain), third degree (hemorrhagic blisters, necrosis, full-thickness skin loss), fourth degree (deep tissue necrosis, mummification, autoamputation).

## Frotteuristic Disorder

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent, intense sexual arousal from touching or rubbing against a nonconsenting person, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing distress or impairment or involving acting

on these urges. Typically occurs in crowded public places (subways, buses, concerts).

## Frozen Section

An intraoperative pathology consultation in which a fresh tissue specimen is rapidly frozen, sectioned on a cryostat, and stained with hematoxylin and eosin within 10 to 20 minutes to guide immediate surgical decision-making. It is used to establish benign versus malignant, assess margins, and identify lymph node metastases.

## Frozen Shoulder

Adhesive capsulitis: progressive shoulder pain and stiffness. Stages: freezing (pain), frozen (stiffness), thawing (recovery). Associated with diabetes, thyroid disease, immobilization. Treatment: physical therapy, corticosteroid injection, manipulation under anesthesia, arthroscopic capsular release.

### Synonyms:

Adhesive Capsulitis Of Shoulder (Frozen Shoulder)

## Fructosamine

A measurement of glycated serum proteins, primarily albumin, that reflects average glycemia over approximately two to three weeks. It is useful when HbA1c is unreliable because of altered red-cell survival, but it is affected by changes in protein concentration and turnover.

## Fructose Malabsorption

Poor absorption of fructose leading to GI symptoms. Fermentation by bacteria produces gas, osmotic diarrhea. Low-fructose diet beneficial.

## Fructose Metabolism

The enzymatic conversion of fructose primarily in the liver through fructokinase, aldolase B, and downstream glycolytic intermediates. Essential fructosuria is usually benign, whereas aldolase B deficiency causes hereditary fructose intolerance and hypoglycemia after fructose ingestion.

## Fuchs Dystrophy

A progressive corneal endothelial disorder in which endothelial cell loss impairs fluid regulation and

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causes corneal oedema. Early disease may cause morning blur and glare; advanced disease produces persistent oedema, bullae, pain, and reduced vision. Diagnosis is clinical and supported by slit-lamp examination and corneal imaging.

### **Full Agonist**

A full agonist is a drug that binds to a receptor and produces the maximum possible biological response that the receptor can generate, achieving 100 percent of the maximal effect. Full agonists have both high affinity for the receptor and high intrinsic activity, meaning they are very effective at activating the receptor once bound.

### **Functional Asplenia**

Markedly reduced or absent splenic function despite splenic tissue being present. It may result from repeated infarction in sickle cell disease or other disorders and increases the risk of severe bloodstream infection, especially from encapsulated bacteria.

### **Functional Assessment**

Evaluation of ability to perform daily activities. Tools: Barthel Index, Lawton IADL Scale, Katz Index. Identifies needs for assistance, predicts outcomes, guides care planning.

### **Functional Capacity**

The maximum level of physical, cognitive, communication, or self-care performance a person can safely achieve under specified conditions. It is assessed in relation to activities, participation, environment, and personal goals.

### **Functional Dyspepsia**

Chronic epigastric pain or discomfort without identifiable structural cause. The Rome IV criteria include postprandial distress syndrome with early satiety and postprandial fullness, and epigastric pain syndrome with epigastric pain or burning unrelated to meals.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nonulcer Dyspepsia Nonulcer Stomach Pain

### **Functional Electrical Stimulation**

Application of electrical impulses to peripheral nerves or muscles to produce purposeful contraction during a functional task, such as foot clearance during gait or cycling after neurologic injury.

### **Functional Independence Measure**

FIM: standardized assessment of disability. Scores 18 (total assistance) to 7 (independent). 18 items: self-care, sphincter control, transfers, locomotion, communication, social cognition.

### **Functional MRI**

An MRI method that estimates brain activity by detecting task-related changes in blood oxygenation and blood flow. It is used in research and in selected preoperative assessments.

### **Functional Neurological Disorder**

Neurologic symptoms such as weakness, abnormal movements, sensory loss, or seizures that are incompatible with recognized patterns of structural neurologic disease and arise from altered nervous-system function. Diagnosis is based on positive clinical signs, not merely on normal investigations.

### **Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder**

A condition in which neurological symptoms such as weakness, abnormal movement, sensory loss, or episodes resembling seizures are incompatible with recognized neurological disease patterns and cause significant distress or impairment.

### **Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder (Conversion Disorder)**

A condition in which patients present with neurological symptoms (weakness, paralysis, non-epileptic seizures, sensory loss, gait abnormalities, dystonia, speech difficulties) that cannot be explained by structural neurological disease. The symptoms are not intentionally produced (unlike malingering or factitious disorder).

#### **Synonyms:**

Conversion Disorder

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## Functional Residual Capacity

The volume of air remaining in the lungs at the end of a normal expiration, equal to the sum of expiratory reserve volume plus residual volume (approximately 2.2-3 L in adults). FRC represents the lung volume at which the outward recoil of the chest wall balances the inward recoil of the lungs, the resting equilibrium position.

## Functional Screening

A brief assessment of a person's ability to perform daily activities, move safely, communicate, and manage basic self-care.

## Functional Status

Ability to perform activities of daily living (ADLs) and instrumental ADLs (IADLs). ADLs: bathing, dressing, toileting, transferring, continence, feeding. IADLs: shopping, cooking, managing medications, finances, transportation, housekeeping. Decline indicates need for assistance.

## Functional Urinary Incontinence

Urinary incontinence due to physical or cognitive impairment preventing toilet access.

## Fundal Height

The distance from the symphysis pubis to the top of the uterus measured in centimeters. Used to estimate gestational age and fetal growth. Generally correlates with weeks of gestation between 20-36 weeks (e.g., 24 cm at 24 weeks). Discrepancies may suggest fetal growth restriction, macrosomia, polyhydramnios, or multiple gestation.

## Fundus Photography

The documentation of the appearance of the retina, optic nerve, and retinal vasculature using a specialized camera that illuminates and photographs the posterior segment of the eye, providing a permanent, objective record of retinal findings that can be used for comparison over time, patient education, and telemedicine consultations.

## Fungal Arthritis

Infection and inflammation of a joint caused by

a fungus, usually after surgery, trauma, injection, bloodstream spread, or in a person with impaired immunity. It often develops gradually with persistent pain, swelling, and reduced movement. Joint-fluid culture and tissue testing guide prolonged antifungal and sometimes surgical treatment.

## Fungal Endophthalmitis

Fungal infection of the interior of the eye, often associated with bloodstream infection, surgery, trauma, or immunosuppression and capable of causing severe visual loss.

## Fungal Infection

An infection caused by a fungus. It may be superficial, affecting the skin, nails, or mucous membranes, or invasive, affecting the lungs, bloodstream, or other organs. The presentation and risk depend on the organism and the person's immune status.

## Fungal Infection (Tinea/Dermatophytosis)

Superficial fungal infections of skin, hair, or nails caused by dermatophytes (*Trichophyton*, *Microsporum*, *Epidermophyton*). Tinea corporis (ringworm): annular scaling plaque with central clearing. Tinea pedis (athlete's foot): interdigital scaling, maceration. Tinea cruris (jock itch): groin rash sparing scrotum.

### Synonyms:

Tinea/Dermatophytosis

## Fungal Nail Infection

Infection of a fingernail or toenail by dermatophytes or other fungi, causing thickening, discoloration, brittleness, separation from the nail bed, or subungual debris.

## Fungal Nails

A fungal infection of the nail, usually caused by dermatophytes, producing thickened, discolored, brittle, or crumbly nails. The infection may spread to surrounding skin and recur. Diagnosis may require microscopy or culture, and treatment depends on the organism, number of nails, severity, and the person's medical history.

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**Synonyms:**

Onychomycosis (Fungal Nails)

**Fungal Pathogenesis**

The mechanisms by which fungi cause disease. Fungal pathogenesis involves adhesion, invasion, and evasion of host defences. Adhesins mediate attachment to host cells. Invasive hyphae penetrate tissues. Capsules and melanin protect against immune responses.

**Fungal Resistance Mechanisms**

Mechanisms by which fungi develop resistance to antifungal agents. Azole resistance occurs through up-regulation of efflux pumps (CDR1, CDR2, MDR1), mutations in the target enzyme ERG11, and over-expression of ERG11. Echinocandin resistance is primarily due to mutations in the FKS1 and FKS2 genes encoding beta-(1,3)-D-glucan synthase.

**Fungal Skin Infections**

Skin infections caused by dermatophytes or yeasts, including ringworm (tinea), athlete's foot, and candidiasis. These infections thrive in warm, moist environments and present with red, itchy, scaly, or ring-shaped lesions. Treatment typically involves topical or oral antifungal medications and measures to keep the skin clean and dry.

**Fungemia**

The presence of viable fungi in the bloodstream. *Candida* species are the most common cause in hospitalized patients; fungemia requires prompt evaluation for a source, metastatic infection, and appropriate antifungal treatment.

**Fungus**

A eukaryotic microorganism with a chitin cell wall and ergosterol-containing membrane, classified as yeasts, moulds, or dimorphic fungi. Reproducing by spores, fungi cause superficial, mucosal, subcutaneous, and systemic infections, especially in immunocompromised hosts.

**Furuncle**

A painful, pus-filled infection of a hair follicle, usu-

ally caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*. It may form an erythematous nodule with a central necrotic core or progress to a skin abscess. Treatment depends on size, location, recurrence, and systemic illness and may include drainage or antimicrobial therapy.

**Furuncle And Carbuncle**

Furuncle (boil) is a deep infection of the hair follicle caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*, presenting as a painful, erythematous nodule that may drain pus. Carbuncle is a cluster of interconnected furuncles causing a larger, more deeply invasive infection.

**Furuncular Myiasis**

A cutaneous infestation caused by larvae of certain fly species (such as *Dermatobia hominis* or *Cuterebra*) that develop within boil-like furuncular lesions in the skin, presenting with a painful, erythematous nodule with a central punctum through which the larva breathes.

**Furunculosis**

Recurrent or multiple furuncles, which are deep infections of hair follicles and surrounding tissue, usually caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*. Lesions are painful, erythematous, and purulent and may occur with colonization, close-contact transmission, skin disease, diabetes, immune dysfunction, or other risk factors.

**Fusariosis**

An opportunistic invasive fungal infection caused by *Fusarium* species, affecting predominantly immunocompromised patients, particularly those with prolonged neutropenia or hematological malignancies. It causes disseminated infection with skin lesions, bloodstream infection, and involvement of multiple organs.

**Fusion**

Union of two tooth buds. Results in large tooth with reduced tooth count.

**Fabry's Disease**

An inherited disorder in which a lipid accumulates in cells, causing pain, skin findings, kidney disease,



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and heart or nervous-system complications.

### **Facial Nerve**

The seventh cranial nerve, which controls facial expression and carries taste sensation from part of the tongue.

### **Factor V**

A blood-clotting protein required for formation of thrombin and fibrin.

### **False Positive**

A test result that indicates a disease or condition is present when it is not.

### **Familial Dysautonomia**

An inherited disorder that impairs development and function of sensory and autonomic nerves.

### **Fatty Liver**

Excess accumulation of fat in liver cells.

#### **Synonyms:**

NAFLD (Fatty Liver)

### **Femoral Neuropathy**

Damage to the femoral nerve, causing weakness or sensory loss in the thigh and leg.

### **Filarial Elephantiasis**

Severe swelling and thickening of tissues caused by lymphatic obstruction from filarial infection.

### **Flat Affect**

Markedly reduced outward expression of emotion.

### **Focal Glomerulosclerosis**

Scarring affecting some glomeruli or only parts of affected glomeruli, which can impair kidney filtration.

### **Foodborne Disease**

Illness caused by eating food or drinking water contaminated with infectious organisms, toxins, or harmful chemicals.

### **Frasier Syndrome**

A rare genetic disorder associated with abnormal sexual development, kidney disease, and increased risk of gonadal tumors.

### **Friedreich's Ataxia**

An inherited degenerative disorder causing progressive problems with coordination, sensation, and heart function.

### **Fuchs' Dystrophy**

A progressive disorder in which corneal endothelial cells deteriorate, causing corneal swelling and impaired vision.

### **Fucosidosis**

A rare inherited metabolic disorder caused by deficiency of the enzyme alpha-L-fucosidase.

### **Funisitis**

Inflammation of the umbilical cord, usually associated with infection or an inflammatory response.

### **Fowler Position**

A semiupright position in which the head and upper body are elevated, usually about 45 to 60 degrees.

### **Facet Rhizotomy**

A procedure that interrupts selected sensory nerves supplying spinal facet joints to reduce chronic pain.

### **Fasting Plasma Glucose Test**

A blood test that measures glucose after fasting and helps diagnose diabetes or impaired glucose regulation.

### **Fecal Occult Blood Test**

A test that detects small amounts of blood in stool, often for colorectal cancer screening.

### **Filtering Procedure**

An operation that creates an alternate drainage pathway to lower pressure inside the eye, usually in glaucoma.



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### **Frontotemporal Lobar Degeneration**

A group of progressive disorders affecting the frontal and temporal brain lobes, causing changes in behavior, language, or executive function.

### **Fundoplication**

Surgery that wraps the upper stomach around the lower esophagus to reduce gastroesophageal reflux.

### **Female Sexual Dysfunction**

Persistent sexual problems in a woman that cause distress, such as low desire, arousal difficulty, or pain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sexual Dysfunction, Female

### **Floor Of The Mouth Cancer**

Cancer that develops in the tissues beneath the tongue.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Floor Of The Mouth

### **Functional Neurologic Disorder**

A condition in which changes in nervous-system function cause symptoms that are not explained by structural damage.

### **Fontanel**

A soft membranous gap between the bones of an infant's skull.

### **Foramen**

An opening or passage through a bone or other anatomical structure, usually for nerves or blood vessels.

### **Fossa**

A shallow depression or hollow in a bone or other body structure.

### **Fremitus**

A vibration felt or heard through body tissues, often used to assess transmitted voice sounds in the chest.

### **Fulguration**

Destruction of tissue by applying electrical energy, commonly during a surgical procedure.

### **Facies**

A characteristic facial appearance that may provide clues to an underlying disease or physiologic condition.

### **Fascia**

A layer or band of connective tissue that surrounds, separates, and supports muscles, organs, nerves, and blood vessels.

### **Fasciculation**

An involuntary, brief twitch of a small group of muscle fibers, often caused by irritation or disease of a motor nerve.

### **Fetal Circulation**

The circulation before birth in which the placenta supplies oxygen and nutrients and fetal shunts direct much of the blood away from the lungs.

### **Fixation**

Stabilization of tissue or bone in a desired position, using methods such as sutures, wires, screws, plates, or external devices.

### **Free Thyroxine Index**

A calculated estimate of circulating free thyroxine based on the total thyroxine concentration and a measure of thyroid-hormone binding.

### **Full-Thickness Skin Graft**

A skin graft containing the entire epidermis and dermis, transferred to cover a wound or reconstruct a defect.

### **Functional Murmur**

A heart murmur caused by increased blood flow without a structural abnormality of the heart or valves.

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## **Fundus**

The rounded or farthest part of a hollow organ; examples include the upper stomach and the posterior interior surface of the eye.

## **Fahr Disease**

A rare neurologic disorder characterized by abnormal, often bilateral, calcification of the basal ganglia and other brain regions, with movement, cognitive, psychiatric, or seizure manifestations. Primary familial brain calcification is the preferred modern term for many inherited cases.

## **Factor XI Deficiency**

An inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by inadequate factor XI activity, producing variable bleeding that is often most apparent after surgery, dental procedures, or trauma.

## **Fecalith**

A hard mass of inspissated fecal material, commonly found in the appendix or colon, that can contribute to appendicitis or intestinal obstruction.

## **Fecaluria**

Passage of fecal material or fecal odor in the urine, usually indicating an abnormal connection such as an enterovesical fistula.

## **Falciparum Malaria**

Severe malaria caused by the parasite *Plasmodium falciparum* and transmitted by infected *Anopheles* mosquitoes. It can rapidly cause cerebral malaria, severe anemia, kidney injury, respiratory distress, or death and requires urgent treatment.

## **Female Athlete Triad**

A syndrome involving low energy availability, menstrual dysfunction, and decreased bone mineral density in physically active females. It is related to inadequate nutrition, excessive exercise, or both, and increases the risk of stress fractures and other health problems.

## **Fulminant Hepatitis**

Rapid, severe loss of liver function caused by extensive hepatic injury, often accompanied by coagulopathy and hepatic encephalopathy. It is a medical emergency that may require intensive care and liver transplantation.

## **Factor IX**

A vitamin K-dependent blood-clotting protein in the intrinsic coagulation pathway. Inherited deficiency causes hemophilia B.

## **Fibrillation**

Rapid, irregular, and uncoordinated contraction of muscle fibers. Atrial fibrillation causes an irregular atrial rhythm; ventricular fibrillation is a cardiac arrest rhythm requiring immediate resuscitation.

## **First Aid**

Immediate basic care given to a person who is injured or suddenly ill before definitive medical treatment is available. Priorities include scene safety, emergency activation, airway, breathing, circulation, and control of serious bleeding.

## **Fits (Seizures)**

A common term for episodes caused by abnormal electrical activity in the brain, which may produce altered awareness, abnormal movements, sensory symptoms, or loss of consciousness.

### **Synonyms:**

Seizures

## **Fluid Balance**

The relationship between fluid intake and output, regulated by the kidneys, hormones, thirst, and other mechanisms. Imbalance may cause dehydration, fluid overload, or electrolyte disturbances.

## **Foramen Ovale**

An opening between the right and left atria of the fetal heart that allows blood to bypass the lungs. It normally closes functionally after birth; persistence is called a patent foramen ovale.

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### **Foreskin (Prepuce)**

A fold of skin covering and protecting the glans penis. It is normally retractable after separation from the glans, although the timing varies.

#### **Synonyms:**

Prepuce

### **Freckles (Ephelides)**

Small, flat, light-brown macules caused by increased melanin production, usually becoming more noticeable with ultraviolet exposure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ephelides

### **Frenum (Frenulum)**

A fold of mucous membrane or skin that anchors or limits movement of a body part, such as the lingual frenulum beneath the tongue or the labial frenula.

#### **Synonyms:**

Frenulum

### **Full Blood Count (FBC)**

A laboratory test measuring red blood cells, hemoglobin, hematocrit, white blood cells, and platelets, often including red-cell indices and a white-cell differential.

#### **Synonyms:**

FBC

### **Functional Disorder**

A condition in which symptoms or impaired function occur without a sufficient structural abnormality to explain them. Functional disorders are real and may involve altered nervous-system or physiological processing.

### **Fourth Stage Of Labor**

The first one to two hours after delivery of the placenta, when the mother is observed for uterine contraction, bleeding, vital-sign changes, and early postpartum complications.

### **Fab Immunoglobulins**

Fab immunoglobulins are antibody molecules or antibody fragments containing antigen-binding Fab

regions; they recognize specific epitopes and are used in immune assays, therapeutics, and research.

### **Face**

The face is the front part of the head, containing the eyes, nose, mouth, cheeks, and jaw; its movement is mainly supplied by the facial nerve and sensation by the trigeminal nerve.

### **Facet Joint**

A small synovial joint between neighboring vertebral arches that guides spinal movement and can cause localized neck or back pain when arthritic.

### **Facial Asymmetry**

Facial asymmetry is unequal shape or movement between the two sides of the face, caused by normal variation, development, injury, nerve disease, or a mass.

### **Facial Cleft**

A facial cleft is a congenital gap from incomplete fusion of embryonic facial structures and may involve the lip, nose, palate, or other tissues.

### **Facial Expression**

Facial expression is visible movement or configuration of facial muscles conveying emotion, communication, pain, or neurologic information.

### **Facial Muscle**

facial muscle refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Facial Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting facial neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Facial Nucleus**

The facial nucleus is a brainstem motor nucleus whose seventh cranial nerve fibers control muscles of facial expression.

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## Facial Paresis

Facial paresis is weakness of facial muscles from dysfunction of the facial nerve or its central pathways, causing drooping, incomplete eye closure, or asymmetric expression.

## Facial Vein

The facial vein drains blood from the face into deeper venous channels and can provide a route for spread of infection in rare circumstances.

## Facklamia

facklamia is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Facklamia Hominis

facklamia hominis is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Factor Xii

factor xii is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## Factor Xiii

factor xiii is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## Factorial Study

factorial study is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## Faculty

The teaching and research staff of an academic institution; in medicine, faculty may educate learners, conduct research, and supervise clinical training.

## Faecalibacterium

faecalibacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Faecalibacterium Prausnitzii

faecalibacterium prausnitzii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Fair Hair

Hair with relatively low melanin content, appearing blond, light brown, or red; color reflects inherited pigment production and can change with age or exposure.

## Falimarev

An investigational antiviral monoclonal antibody studied for prevention or treatment of selected viral infections; its use depends on trial evidence and authorization.

## Famciclovir

A medicine or chemical compound called famciclovir. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Familial Testotoxicosis

Familial testotoxicosis is an activating mutation of the luteinizing-hormone receptor causing gonadotropin-independent precocious puberty in boys, with high testosterone but low prepubertal LH and FSH.

## Family

A group of biologically or socially related people whose shared history, genes, environment, and support relationships can affect health risk and care.

## Family Medicine

A medical specialty providing comprehensive contin-

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uing care for people of all ages, including prevention, acute illness, chronic disease, and coordination of referrals.

### **Family Planning**

Healthcare and personal decision-making about whether and when to have children, including contraception, fertility care, preconception health, and pregnancy planning.

### **Family Study**

family study is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Famophos**

Famophos is an organophosphate insecticide; exposure can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity, including salivation, sweating, vomiting, bronchospasm, bradycardia, and muscle weakness.

### **Famotidine**

Famotidine is a histamine H<sub>2</sub>-receptor antagonist that reduces gastric-acid secretion and is used for peptic ulcer disease, gastro-oesophageal reflux, and hypersecretory states; dose adjustment may be needed in renal impairment.

### **Farad**

The SI unit of electrical capacitance, equal to one coulomb per volt, relevant to biomedical instrumentation and electrophysiology.

### **Farber Lipogranulomatosis**

A rare autosomal-recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by acid ceramidase deficiency, producing painful subcutaneous nodules, joint contractures, and hoarseness.

### **Fascia Adherens**

A fascia adherens is a cell junction that anchors actin filaments between adjacent cells, especially in cardiac muscle intercalated discs.

### **Fasciola**

fasciola is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Fasciola Hepatica**

fasciola hepatica is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Fasciolopsis Buski**

Fasciolopsis buski is the large intestinal fluke that causes fasciolopsiasis after ingestion of metacercariae on contaminated aquatic plants; heavy infection can cause abdominal pain, diarrhoea, malnutrition, or oedema.

### **Fasting**

Fasting is abstaining from food, and sometimes drink, for a defined period before testing, treatment, surgery, or for personal or religious reasons.

### **Fat Body**

The fat body is an organ-like tissue in insects that stores lipid, produces metabolic proteins, and performs functions analogous to liver and adipose tissue.

### **Fat Measurement**

fat measurement is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Fat Pad**

A fat pad is a localized collection of adipose tissue that cushions, supports, insulates, or permits movement around an organ or joint.

### **Fat-Soluble Vitamin**

A vitamin that dissolves in fat and can be stored in liver and adipose tissue; vitamins A, D, E, and K can accumulate and cause toxicity when excessive.

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## **Fatty Degeneration**

Accumulation of abnormal lipid within cells, especially liver cells, caused by metabolic stress, alcohol, toxins, malnutrition, obesity, or other injury.

## **Favism**

Acute hemolysis after eating fava beans or inhaling pollen in a person with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency, triggered by oxidative stress.

## **Fazarabine**

Fazarabine is a cytidine analogue antimetabolite investigated as an anticancer drug; it interferes with nucleic-acid synthesis and may cause myelosuppression and other chemotherapy toxicities.

## **Fc Receptor**

A cell-surface receptor that binds the Fc portion of an antibody and mediates phagocytosis, antibody-dependent cytotoxicity, inflammation, or immune regulation.

## **Fear**

An emotional and physiologic response to perceived threat, involving vigilance, autonomic arousal, avoidance, and protective behavior; excessive fear can be pathological.

## **Febrile Convulsion**

A seizure occurring with fever in a young child without evidence of central nervous system infection or another acute cause; most are brief and generalized.

## **Febuxostat**

Febuxostat is a selective xanthine-oxidase inhibitor used to lower urate in chronic hyperuricaemia and gout; it is not a treatment for immediate pain and requires attention to cardiovascular risk and liver function.

## **Fec Protocol**

A chemotherapy regimen combining fluorouracil, epirubicin, and cyclophosphamide, used for selected cancers with dosing and monitoring determined by oncology protocols.

## **Feces**

The solid or semisolid waste expelled from the bowel, containing undigested material, water, bacteria, shed cells, and metabolic waste.

## **Feeding Methods**

feeding methods is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## **Feeding Poor**

Poor feeding means an infant or patient takes inadequate food or fluid and may reflect illness, swallowing difficulty, breathing problems, pain, or developmental issues.

## **Felbamate**

Felbamate is an antiseizure medicine used selectively for refractory epilepsy, including Lennox–Gastaut syndrome; potentially fatal aplastic anaemia and liver failure require specialist use and monitoring.

## **Felodipine**

Felodipine is a dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker used mainly for hypertension; arteriolar vasodilation can cause ankle oedema, flushing, headache, palpitations, or gingival enlargement.

## **Female**

Female describes the sex category generally associated with ova production and female reproductive anatomy, while recognizing biological variation and gender identity distinctions.

## **Female Breast**

The female breast contains glandular tissue, ducts, fat, skin, nerves, and blood vessels and can undergo changes with hormones, pregnancy, lactation, aging, or disease.

## **Female Condom**

A female condom is a sheath placed in the vagina that provides a barrier against sperm and can reduce transmission of some sexually transmitted infections



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when used correctly.

### **Female Genitalia**

Female genitalia include the vulva and internal reproductive organs such as the vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, and ovaries.

### **Female Phenotype**

A female phenotype is the observable combination of anatomical, physiologic, and developmental traits associated with female sex, which can vary with genes and hormones.

### **Feminization**

Development of physical or hormonal traits typically associated with female sexual development, occurring normally, therapeutically, or through endocrine disorders.

### **Femtogram**

A femtogram is a unit of mass equal to one quadrillionth of a gram, or  $10^{-15}$  grams.

### **Femtoliter**

A femtoliter is a unit of volume equal to one quadrillionth of a liter, or  $10^{-15}$  liters.

### **Femur Fracture**

A break in the thigh bone, caused by major trauma or weakened bone; location and displacement determine blood loss, mobility, nerve and vessel risk, and treatment.

### **Fenamiphos**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenamiphos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenclonine**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenclonine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenfluramine**

Fenfluramine is a serotonergic medicine used in

some jurisdictions for selected severe epileptic encephalopathies; historical appetite-suppressant use was limited by valvular heart disease and pulmonary hypertension, so cardiac monitoring is required.

### **Fenitrothion**

fenitrothion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Fenobucarb**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenobucarb. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenoldopam**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenoldopam. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenoprofen**

Fenoprofen is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain and inflammatory arthritis; gastrointestinal bleeding, renal injury, fluid retention, and cardiovascular events are important risks.

### **Fenoterol**

A medicine or chemical compound called fenoterol. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fenoxycarb**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenoxycarb. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenretinide**

A clinical condition or finding involving fenretinide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fentanyl**

A clinical condition or finding involving fentanyl. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management

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agement depend on the clinical context.

### **Fentanyl Citrate**

A clinical condition or finding involving fentanyl citrate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fenthion**

fenthion is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Fermentation**

A metabolic process in which microorganisms or cells convert organic substrates without using oxidative respiration, producing products such as acids, alcohols, or gases.

### **Ferredoxin**

An iron–sulfur electron-transfer protein that participates in photosynthesis, steroid synthesis, and mitochondrial or bacterial redox reactions.

### **Ferroptosis**

A regulated form of cell death caused by iron-dependent lipid-peroxide accumulation and loss of antioxidant protection, distinct from apoptosis and necrosis.

### **Ferrous Sulfate**

Ferrous sulfate is an oral iron salt used to treat or prevent iron-deficiency anaemia; nausea, constipation, dark stools, and accidental overdose toxicity can occur.

### **Fertility Agent**

A medicine or biologic intervention intended to improve the chance of conception by inducing ovulation, supporting sperm production, or treating a reproductive mechanism.

### **Fertility Domain**

The reproductive dimension of health involving ability to conceive, reproductive function, fertility goals,

infertility, and related medical or psychosocial care.

### **Fertilization**

Fusion of sperm and egg genetic material to form a zygote, usually in the fallopian tube, initiating embryonic development.

### **Ferumoxytol**

An intravenous iron-carbohydrate complex used to treat iron-deficiency anemia in selected adults; hypersensitivity and hypotension require monitoring during infusion.

### **Fetal Bradyarrhythmia**

Fetal bradyarrhythmia is an abnormally slow or irregular fetal heart rhythm caused by conduction disease, maternal antibodies, medicines, or other factors.

### **Fetal Death**

A clinical condition involving fetal Death; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Fetal Disease**

A clinical condition involving fetal Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Fetal Heart**

The fetal heart is the developing heart that circulates blood through fetal and placental pathways before birth and changes rapidly during gestation.

### **Fetal Hemoglobin**

Fetal hemoglobin is the oxygen-binding hemoglobin predominant before birth and early infancy, with higher oxygen affinity than adult hemoglobin.

### **Fetal Malpresentation**

Fetal malpresentation occurs when a part other than the usual vertex head position leads during labor, such as breech, transverse, or face presentation.

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### **Fetal Pyelectasis**

Fetal pyelectasis is mild dilation of the renal pelvis seen on prenatal ultrasound and may be transient or associated with urinary obstruction or other findings.

### **Fetal Stage**

The fetal stage begins after the embryonic period and continues until birth, characterized mainly by growth and maturation of established organs.

### **Fetal Tissue**

Fetal tissue is tissue from a developing fetus and may be relevant to pregnancy care, pathology, research, transplantation, or genetic testing under applicable ethical and legal rules.

### **Fetal Weight**

Fetal weight is an estimate of a fetus's mass, usually from ultrasound measurements, used to assess growth and identify possible growth restriction or macrosomia.

### **Fetomaternal Transfusion**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to fetomaternal transfusion; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Fibrinogen Assay**

A fibrinogen assay measures plasma fibrinogen concentration or function, commonly by the Clauss method; low results may occur in consumption, severe liver disease, or inherited deficiency, while inflammation can increase the level.

### **Fibrinogen Decreased**

Decreased fibrinogen is a low plasma fibrinogen level that can impair clot formation and cause bleeding; causes include disseminated intravascular coagulation, severe hepatic failure, massive transfusion, and congenital deficiency.

### **Fibrinolytic Agent**

A fibrinolytic agent is a thrombolytic drug, such as

alteplase or tenecteplase, that converts plasminogen to plasmin and dissolves fibrin clots; major bleeding, including intracranial haemorrhage, is the principal danger.

### **Fibrofolliculoma**

A benign perifollicular skin tumor, often multiple on the face, that is characteristic of Birt-Hogg-Dubé syndrome when associated with other findings.

### **Fibroid Tumor**

A neoplastic process affecting fibroid tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Fibrolipoma**

A benign tumor composed of mature fat and abundant fibrous tissue, usually presenting as a slow-growing painless soft-tissue mass.

### **Fibromatosis**

A proliferation of fibroblasts and myofibroblasts that is usually nonmetastatic but can infiltrate locally and recur, as in desmoid-type fibromatosis.

### **Fibromyxosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting fibromyxosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Fibronectin**

A clinical condition or finding involving fibronectin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ficusin**

A clinical condition or finding involving ficusin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fidaxomicin**

A clinical condition or finding involving fidaxomicin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## **Fiducial Markers**

fiducial markers is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## **Filamentous Fungus**

filamentous fungus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Filaria Bancrofti**

Filaria bancrofti is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

## **Filaria Demarquay**

filaria demarquay is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

## **Filarial Elephantiasis**

filarial elephantiasis is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

## **Filgrastim**

A clinical condition or finding involving filgrastim. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Filler Excipient**

filler excipient is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## **Filopodium**

A slender, actin-rich projection from a cell surface that senses the environment and helps cells migrate,

adhere, or establish neuronal connections.

## **Filoviridae**

filoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## **Fimbriae Proteins**

Bacterial surface proteins that form fimbriae or pili and mediate attachment to host cells, surfaces, or biofilms.

## **Finegoldia**

A biomedical term referring to finegoldia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## **Finegoldia Magna**

A biomedical term referring to finegoldia magna; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## **Finger**

A finger is one of the digits of the hand containing bones, joints, tendons, nerves, vessels, skin, and a nail.

## **Finger Flexors**

Finger flexors are forearm and hand muscles whose tendons bend the fingers at their joints and contribute to grip.

## **Finger Injury**

Damage to a finger's bone, joint, tendon, ligament, nerve, vessel, nail, or skin caused by trauma and assessed for deformity, circulation, sensation, and function.

## **Finger Joint**

A finger joint is an articulation between finger bones that permits flexion, extension, and controlled hand movement.

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### **Firefly Family**

A clinical condition or finding involving firefly family. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Firesetting Behavior**

Deliberate setting of fires, ranging from isolated behavior to recurrent fire-setting associated with impulse-control, psychiatric, developmental, substance-use, or social problems.

### **Firmicutes**

A biomedical term referring to firmicutes; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Fish Oil**

fish oil is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Fish Venom**

fish venom is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Fixative**

fixative is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fixed Macrophage**

A resident tissue macrophage that remains in a particular organ rather than circulating, where it removes debris and contributes to immune surveillance and repair.

### **Flagellin**

The structural protein forming bacterial flagella and an activator of innate immunity through Toll-like receptor 5.

### **Flagellum**

A long whip-like cellular or bacterial appendage that produces movement or helps a microorganism swim.

### **Flare-Up**

A sudden or gradual increase in symptoms or inflammatory activity of a chronic disease after a period of stability or lower activity.

### **Flavin**

flavin is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Flaviviridae**

flaviviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Flavivirus**

flavivirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Flavobacteriaceae**

flavobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Flavobacterium**

flavobacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Flavodoxin**

Flavodoxin is a small flavin-containing electron-transfer protein, usually containing FMN, that par-

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icipates in redox reactions in some bacteria, algae, and other organisms.

### **Flavonifractor**

flavonifractor is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Flavonoid**

flavonoid is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Flavonol**

flavonol is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Flavopiridol**

A clinical condition or finding involving flavopiridol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Flavor Enhancer**

A flavour enhancer is a food additive that intensifies existing taste, often savoury or umami flavour, without serving mainly as a sweetener or preservative; sensitivity and exposure depend on the substance and dose.

### **Flavoxate**

A clinical condition or finding involving flavoxate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Flaxseed Extract**

A preparation derived from flaxseed containing variable amounts of alpha-linolenic acid, lignans, and soluble fiber; effects and interactions depend on formulation and dose.

### **Flea**

flea is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical

importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Fleshy Tab**

A small projection of soft tissue, often a skin tag or mucosal appendage, whose cause and significance depend on its site and appearance.

### **Flocculation**

The aggregation of suspended particles into larger loose clumps, used in laboratory separation, water treatment, and some biologic or pharmaceutical processes.

### **Flowmeter**

flowmeter is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Floxacin**

A medicine or chemical compound called floxacillin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Floxuridine**

A clinical condition or finding involving floxuridine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluconazole**

A medicine or chemical compound called fluconazole. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Flucytosine**

A clinical condition or finding involving flucytosine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fludarabine**

A clinical condition or finding involving fludarabine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.



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### **Fludarabine Phosphate**

A clinical condition or finding involving fludarabine phosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fludrocortisone**

A clinical condition or finding involving fludrocortisone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluid Management**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to fluid management; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Fluocinolone Acetonide**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluocinolone acetonide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluocinonide**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluocinonide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluorescein**

fluorescein is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fluorescence**

fluorescence is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fluorescence Microscopy**

fluorescence microscopy is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fluorescence Polarization**

fluorescence polarization is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fluorescent Dye**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluorescent dye. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluoride Poisoning**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving fluoride poisoning; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Fluorimetry**

fluorimetry is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Fluorine**

fluorine is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fluorometholone**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluorometholone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluorophotometry**

fluorophotometry is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Fluoropyrimidine**

A fluoropyrimidine is an antimetabolite resembling pyrimidine bases; drugs such as fluorouracil and capecitabine disrupt thymidylate and nucleic-acid

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synthesis in cancer cells.

### **Fluoroquinolone**

A fluoroquinolone is a bactericidal antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; class risks include tendinopathy or tendon rupture, neuropathy, QT prolongation, dysglycaemia, and central-nervous-system effects.

### **Fluorouracil**

Fluorouracil is a fluoropyrimidine antimetabolite that inhibits thymidylate synthase; topical treatment is used for selected actinic or superficial lesions and systemic treatment for cancers, with mucositis, diarrhoea, myelosuppression, and DPYD-related severe toxicity possible.

### **Fluoxetine**

Fluoxetine is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor used for depression, obsessive-compulsive disorder, panic disorder, bulimia nervosa, and premenstrual dysphoric disorder; its long half-life and serotonergic interactions are clinically important.

### **Fluoxymesterone**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluoxymesterone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluphenazine**

A medicine or chemical compound called fluphenazine. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fluphenazine Hydrochloride**

A medicine or chemical compound called fluphenazine hydrochloride. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Flurandrenolide**

A clinical condition or finding involving flurandrenolide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Flurazepam**

A medicine or chemical compound called flurazepam. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Flurbiprofen**

Flurbiprofen is an NSAID used for pain and inflammation and, in some formulations, ocular inflammation; gastrointestinal, renal, cardiovascular, and hypersensitivity adverse effects are possible.

### **Flutamide**

A clinical condition or finding involving flutamide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluticasone**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluticasone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluvastatin**

A medicine or chemical compound called fluvastatin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fluvoxamine**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluvoxamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **fMRI**

fMRI is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Foam Cell**

A lipid-filled macrophage or other cell with a foamy appearance, commonly found in atherosclerotic plaques and some inflammatory or storage disorders.

### **Focal**

Limited to a specific site or region rather than dis-

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tributed diffusely; imaging, pathology, seizures, and neurologic deficits may be described as focal.

### **Focal Adhesion**

A cell-matrix attachment complex linking integrins to the actin cytoskeleton and regulating adhesion, force sensing, migration, and signaling.

### **Foetal Acidosis**

Abnormally low fetal blood pH from inadequate oxygenation or impaired gas exchange, assessed through fetal monitoring and, when available, fetal blood sampling.

### **Folate**

Folate is vitamin B9, required for one-carbon transfer, DNA synthesis, and normal red-cell formation; deficiency causes megaloblastic anaemia and in pregnancy increases neural-tube-defect risk, while supplementation can mask vitamin-B12 deficiency.

### **Folate Antagonist**

A folate antagonist blocks folate-dependent enzymes or transport and thereby impairs nucleotide synthesis; examples include methotrexate and trimethoprim, used as anticancer, immunosuppressive, or antimicrobial drugs.

### **Folic Acid**

A synthetic form of folate, a B vitamin required for nucleotide synthesis and red-cell production; supplementation prevents neural-tube defects and treats deficiency.

### **Follicular Fluid**

Follicular fluid is the fluid within an ovarian follicle surrounding the developing oocyte and containing hormones and signaling molecules.

### **Follicular Hyperkeratosis**

Follicular hyperkeratosis is excess keratin blocking hair follicles and producing rough small bumps, commonly seen in keratosis pilaris or deficiency states.

### **Follistatin**

A medicine or chemical compound called follistatin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fomites**

fomites is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Fondaparinux**

A medicine or chemical compound called fondaparinux. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fondaparinux Sodium**

A medicine or chemical compound called fondaparinux sodium. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fonofos**

A clinical condition or finding involving fonofos. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fonsecaea**

fonsecaea is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Food**

Food is material eaten or drunk to provide energy, nutrients, hydration, and building components for the body.

### **Food Consumption**

Food consumption is the amount and pattern of eating and drinking, influenced by appetite, culture, access, health, habits, and metabolic needs.

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## Food Safety

Food safety involves preventing contamination, improper storage, undercooking, and allergen exposure that can cause foodborne illness.

## Foot

The foot is the distal part of the lower limb below the ankle, formed by 26 bones, joints, muscles, tendons, and ligaments; its arches distribute load and support balance and walking.

## Forcible Intercourse

Sexual intercourse imposed without freely given consent through force, threats, coercion, or inability to consent; it is a form of sexual violence requiring safety and medical support.

## Forearm

The forearm is the part of the upper limb between the elbow and wrist, containing the radius, ulna, muscles, nerves, and vessels.

## Forearm Circumference

Forearm circumference is the distance around the forearm and can help assess body composition, muscle bulk, swelling, or growth.

## Forehead

The forehead is the front part of the head above the eyebrows and between the temples, overlying the frontal bone and frontal lobe.

## Forelimb

A forelimb is an anterior limb of an animal, corresponding broadly to an arm or wing in humans and other vertebrates.

## Forensic Medicine

Application of medical knowledge to legal questions, including injury interpretation, cause of death, toxicology, identification, sexual assault evaluation, and documentation.

## Foreskin

The foreskin, or prepuce, is the fold of skin cover-

ing the glans penis and may be retracted in older children and adults unless restricted by disease.

## Foretinib

A clinical condition or finding involving foretinib. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Formate

formate is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Formetanate

formetanate is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Formoterol Fumarate

A medicine or chemical compound called formoterol fumarate. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Formothion

formothion is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Formparanate

formparanate is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

## Fosaprepitant Dimeglumine

A clinical condition or finding involving fosaprepitant dimeglumine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Fosbretabulin**

A clinical condition or finding involving fosbretabulin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Foscarnet**

A clinical condition or finding involving foscarnet. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Foscarnet Sodium**

A clinical condition or finding involving foscarnet sodium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fosfomycin**

A medicine or chemical compound called fosfomycin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fosinopril**

A medicine or chemical compound called fosinopril. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Fotemustine**

A nitrosourea chemotherapy drug that crosses the blood-brain barrier and is used in some settings for malignant melanoma or brain tumors; marrow toxicity is important.

### **Found Dead**

A circumstance in which a person is discovered deceased outside medical observation; forensic evaluation may establish identity, timing, cause, and manner of death.

### **Fourier Analysis**

fourier analysis is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Fourth Finger**

The fourth finger is the ring finger, located between

the middle finger and little finger.

### **Fracture Fixation**

Stabilization of a broken bone with casts, plates, screws, nails, wires, or external frames to restore alignment and permit healing or movement.

### **Fractured Elbow**

A break involving the distal humerus, radial head, olecranon, or another elbow structure that can impair motion and injure nearby nerves or vessels.

### **Fractured Ilium**

A break in the broad upper portion of the pelvic bone, usually from substantial trauma or weakened bone and potentially associated with pelvic-organ or blood-vessel injury.

### **Framycetin**

A clinical condition or finding involving framycetin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Francisella**

francisella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Francisellaceae**

francisellaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Freeze Drying**

Lyophilization, a process that freezes a material and removes ice by sublimation under low pressure to preserve medicines, biologic samples, or foods.

### **Freeze Etching**

A preparation method in which frozen material is fractured and the exposed surface is etched by sublimating ice before microscopic examination.

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### Freeze Substitution

A microscopy preparation method replacing ice in a frozen specimen with an organic solvent at low temperature before fixation and embedding.

### Freezing

A clinical condition or finding involving freezing. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Fresh Specimen

A newly collected biological sample examined promptly or preserved appropriately before degradation alters its cells, organisms, chemistry, or diagnostic features.

### Fresolimumab

A medicine or chemical compound called fresolimumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### Freund's Adjuvant

A clinical condition or finding involving freund's adjuvant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Friend Virus

Friend virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Frontal Bossing

Frontal bossing is prominent bulging of the forehead, which may be familial or associated with skeletal, endocrine, hematologic, or developmental disorders.

### Frustration

An emotional response to blocked goals or unmet needs, potentially producing irritability, anger, distress, avoidance, or behavioral change.

### Fryns Syndrome

A rare usually autosomal-recessive congenital syn-

drome with diaphragmatic hernia, distinctive facial features, distal limb abnormalities, and variable brain, heart, kidney, or genital anomalies.

### Fucose

Fucose is a deoxy sugar found in cell-surface glycoproteins and glycolipids and involved in recognition, adhesion, and immune signaling.

### Fucosyltransferase

An enzyme that transfers fucose to glycans on proteins or lipids, affecting cell recognition, blood-group antigens, development, and host-pathogen interactions.

### Full Sibling

A person who shares both biological parents with another person, relevant to pedigree analysis, genetic risk assessment, and tissue-donor matching.

### Fullerene

fullerene is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### Fulvestrant

A clinical condition or finding involving fulvestrant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Fundus Oculi

The fundus oculi is the inside back surface of the eye, including the retina, optic disc, macula, and retinal blood vessels.

### Fundus Uteri

The fundus uteri is the rounded upper portion of the uterus above the openings of the fallopian tubes.

### Fungal Vaccines

fungal vaccines is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial



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susceptibility.

### **Fungi**

fungi is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Furan**

furan is a chemical, toxicology, laboratory, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, concentration, route, duration, and exposure circumstances.

### **Furazolidone**

A clinical condition or finding involving furazolidone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Furocoumarin**

A clinical condition or finding involving furocoumarin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Furosemide**

Furosemide is a loop diuretic that inhibits the Na-K-2Cl cotransporter in the thick ascending limb; it treats oedema and some hypertensive or acute heart-failure states, but can cause dehydration, electrolyte loss, hypotension, and ototoxicity.

### **Fursultiamin**

A clinical condition or finding involving fursultiamin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fusarium**

fusarium is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Fusarium Chlamydosporum**

fusarium chlamydosporum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends

on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Fusarium Incarnatum**

fusarium incarnatum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Fusarium Solani**

fusarium solani is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Fused Placenta**

A clinical condition or finding involving fused placenta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fused Teeth**

A clinical condition or finding involving fused teeth. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fusidic Acid**

An antibiotic that inhibits bacterial elongation factor G and is used mainly for selected staphylococcal infections; resistance and formulation vary by region.

### **Fusion Gene**

A hybrid gene formed when parts of two separate genes join through chromosomal rearrangement or other mechanism, sometimes producing an oncogenic fusion protein.

### **Fusion Protein**

A protein encoded by a fusion gene or engineered by joining domains from different proteins, potentially changing signaling, localization, or therapeutic activity.

### **Fusobacterium**

fusobacterium is a microorganism or microbial group

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identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Infection**

*Fusobacterium* infection is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Mortiferum**

*Fusobacterium mortiferum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Naviforme**

*Fusobacterium naviforme* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Necrogenes**

*Fusobacterium necrogenes* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Necrophorum**

*Fusobacterium necrophorum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Nucleatum**

*Fusobacterium nucleatum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Russii**

*Fusobacterium russii* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Fusobacterium Varium**

*Fusobacterium varium* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Frequent Bowel Movements**

Passing stool more often than usual; causes include diet, infection, medicines, inflammation, malabsorption, or functional bowel disorders.

### **Frequent Urination**

The need to urinate more often than usual, which may result from increased fluid intake, urinary infection, diabetes, pregnancy, medicines, or bladder disorders.

### **Fatty Liver Disease (MASLD)**

A condition in which excess fat accumulates in the liver, often associated with metabolic risk factors and potentially progressing to inflammation or scarring.

#### **Synonyms:**

MASH MASLD Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease NAFLD

### **Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis (FSGS)**

Kidney disease in which scar tissue affects some portions of some glomeruli, potentially causing protein in urine and progressive kidney failure.

### **Food Poisoning (Foodborne Illness)**

Illness caused by eating food or drinking water contaminated with infectious organisms, toxins, or harmful chemicals.

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## **Fallot, Tetralogy Of**

A congenital heart defect consisting of four abnormalities: ventricular septal defect, right ventricular outflow tract obstruction, overriding aorta, and right ventricular hypertrophy. Causes cyanosis due to right-to-left shunting. Treatment includes surgical repair.

### **Synonyms:**

Tetralogy of Fallot

## **FAP**

Familial adenomatous polyposis: an inherited condition causing hundreds to thousands of colon polyps, with near-certain colorectal cancer if untreated. Caused by APC gene mutations with autosomal dominant inheritance. Managed with prophylactic colectomy.

### **Synonyms:**

Familial adenomatous polyposis

## **Familial Paroxysmal Peritonitis**

Familial Mediterranean fever: an autosomal recessive autoinflammatory disorder causing recurrent fevers and serositis (peritonitis, pleuritis, synovitis). Caused by MEFV gene mutations affecting pyrin regulation.

### **Synonyms:**

Familial Mediterranean fever

## **Fever Blister**

Recurrent herpes simplex labialis: small, painful vesicles on the lips or around the mouth caused by HSV-1. The virus remains latent in trigeminal ganglia and reactivates with stress, illness, or sun exposure. Heals without scarring in 7-10 days.

### **Synonyms:**

Cold sore; herpes labialis

## **Fever, Valley**

Coccidioidomycosis: a fungal infection caused by *Coccidioides* species, endemic to arid regions of the southwestern US and parts of Mexico and Central/South America. Inhalation of spores causes respiratory illness ranging from asymptomatic to severe pneumonia. Dissemination can affect skin, bones, and meninges.

### **Synonyms:**

Valley fever; coccidioidomycosis

## **Fevers, Viral Hemorrhagic**

Severe febrile illnesses caused by various RNA viruses (Ebola, Marburg, dengue, Lassa, Rift Valley fever) transmitted by arthropods or rodents. Characterized by fever, hemorrhage, and multi-organ failure. High mortality rates for some agents. Prevention focuses on vector control and infection prevention.

### **Synonyms:**

Viral hemorrhagic fevers

## **FEC**

Fuchs endothelial corneal dystrophy: a progressive condition affecting the corneal endothelium, leading to corneal edema and vision impairment. More common in women and older adults. Advanced cases may require corneal transplantation.

### **Synonyms:**

Fuchs dystrophy

## **FECD**

Fuchs endothelial corneal dystrophy: a bilateral, progressive corneal disease characterized by loss of endothelial cells, resulting in corneal thickening and decreased vision, especially upon waking. Early stages may be asymptomatic.

### **Synonyms:**

Fuchs dystrophy

## **Fibroids, Uterine**

Benign smooth muscle tumors of the uterus, also called leiomyomas. Common cause of abnormal uterine bleeding, pelvic pain, and bulk symptoms. May affect fertility. Treatment ranges from observation to medical management to surgical removal depending on symptoms and reproductive goals.

### **Synonyms:**

Uterine fibroids; leiomyomas

## **Fibromyalgia Syndrome**

A chronic disorder characterized by widespread musculoskeletal pain, fatigue, unrefreshing sleep, and

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cognitive symptoms. Diagnosis is clinical based on widespread pain index and symptom severity scale. Treatment includes exercise, cognitive behavioral therapy, and medications.

**Synonyms:**

Fibromyalgia

**Fibrosis, Interstitial Pulmonary**

Chronic progressive scarring of lung interstitium, leading to impaired gas exchange. Causes include connective tissue diseases, medications, radiation, and idiopathic sources. Presents with dyspnea, dry cough, and restrictive physiology on pulmonary function tests.

**Synonyms:**

Interstitial lung disease

**Fibrosis, Pulmonary**

Irreversible scarring of lung tissue with thickening of alveolar walls, reducing lung compliance and gas exchange. Idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis is the most common form. Presents with progressive dyspnea, dry cough, and characteristic honeycomb pattern on CT.

**Synonyms:**

Pulmonary fibrosis

**Fistula, Arteriovenous**

An abnormal connection between an artery and vein, bypassing the capillary bed. Can be congenital or acquired (trauma, iatrogenic). In chronic kidney disease, surgical AV fistulas are created for hemodialysis access. Large fistulas can cause high-output heart failure.

**Synonyms:**

Arteriovenous fistula

**Flaviviruses**

A genus of RNA viruses in the Flaviviridae family, transmitted by mosquitoes or ticks. Includes dengue, Zika, yellow fever, and West Nile virus. Many cause significant morbidity and mortality worldwide. Prevention relies on vector control and vaccination where available.

**Floppy Valve Syndrome**

Mitral valve prolapse: a condition in which the mitral valve leaflets bulge back into the left atrium during systole. Often asymptomatic but may cause palpitations, chest pain, or mitral regurgitation. Diagnosis by echocardiography.

**Synonyms:**

Mitral valve prolapse

**Flu, Avian**

Influenza A virus infection in birds, caused by H5N1, H7N9, and other subtypes. Primarily affects poultry but can occasionally infect humans through close contact with infected birds. High mortality rate in human cases. Pandemic potential if sustained human-to-human transmission develops.

**Synonyms:**

Avian influenza; bird flu

**Flu, Bird**

Avian influenza: viral infection of birds that can occasionally spread to humans. H5N1 and H7N9 are the most concerning subtypes for human health. Characterized by severe respiratory illness with high mortality. Prevention includes poultry vaccination and avoiding contact with infected birds.

**Synonyms:**

Avian influenza; bird flu

**Flu, Swine**

Influenza A virus infection in pigs that can occasionally spread to humans. The 2009 H1N1 pandemic strain originated from swine influenza viruses. Symptoms resemble seasonal flu but can be severe in some individuals. Vaccination includes protection against swine flu strains.

**Synonyms:**

H1N1 flu; swine influenza

**Fluid Around The Heart**

Pericardial effusion: abnormal accumulation of fluid in the pericardial space. Can be caused by infection, malignancy, autoimmune disease, trauma, or metabolic conditions. Small effusions may be asymptomatic; large or rapid accumulations can cause cardiac tamponade.

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**Synonyms:**

Pericardial effusion

**FM**

Fibromyalgia: a chronic disorder characterized by widespread pain, fatigue, and cognitive symptoms. Diagnosis is based on clinical criteria. Treatment includes exercise, cognitive behavioral therapy, and medications.

**Synonyms:**

Fibromyalgia

**FMS**

Fibromyalgia syndrome: a chronic condition causing widespread pain, tenderness, fatigue, and sleep disturbances. Affects 2-4% of the population, more common in women. Treatment is multimodal including exercise, therapy, and medications.

**Synonyms:**

Fibromyalgia

**FND**

Functional neurological disorder: a condition where neurological symptoms (weakness, movement abnormalities, seizures, sensory loss) occur without structural disease. Symptoms are real and disabling. Diagnosis requires positive clinical signs. Treatment includes physical therapy, psychotherapy, and education.

**Synonyms:**

Conversion disorder; functional neurologic disorder

**Folate Deficiency Anemia**

Megaloblastic anemia caused by insufficient folate (vitamin B9), characterized by large, immature red blood cells. Causes include poor diet, malabsorption, alcoholism, and medications. Symptoms include fatigue, weakness, and glossitis. Treatment with folic acid supplementation.

**Synonyms:**

Vitamin B9 deficiency anemia

**Food Allergy, Egg**

Immune-mediated hypersensitivity reaction to egg proteins, most common in children. Reactions range

from mild urticaria to severe anaphylaxis. Diagnosis involves skin prick testing and specific IgE levels. Management includes strict avoidance and carrying epinephrine auto-injectors.

**Synonyms:**

Egg allergy

**Food Allergy, Milk**

Hypersensitivity to milk proteins (casein, whey), the most common food allergy in infants and young children. Symptoms include eczema, gastrointestinal upset, and respiratory symptoms. Most children outgrow it by school age. Breastfeeding and hydrolyzed formulas are management options.

**Synonyms:**

Milk allergy

**Food-Borne Illness**

Illness caused by consuming food contaminated with bacteria, viruses, parasites, or toxins. Common pathogens include Salmonella, E. coli, Listeria, and Norovirus. Symptoms include nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, and fever. Prevention involves proper food handling and cooking.

**Synonyms:**

Food poisoning; foodborne illness

**Foot Fracture**

A break in one or more of the 26 bones in the foot (tarsals, metatarsals, phalanges). Can result from trauma, stress, or underlying conditions like osteoporosis. Symptoms include pain, swelling, and inability to bear weight. Treatment ranges from immobilization to surgery.

**Synonyms:**

Broken foot

**Fracture, Arm**

A break in any of the three arm bones: humerus (upper arm), radius, or ulna (forearm). Caused by trauma, falls, or sports injuries. Symptoms include pain, deformity, swelling, and loss of function. Treatment depends on fracture type and may require casting or surgical fixation.

**Synonyms:**

Broken arm

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### Fracture, Growth Plate

A break through the physis (growth plate) in children and adolescents. Can affect future bone growth if not properly treated. Classified by Salter-Harris system. Requires prompt evaluation and appropriate management to prevent growth disturbances.

#### Synonyms:

Growth plate fractures; physeal fractures

### Fracture, Hip

A break in the proximal femur, common in elderly patients with osteoporosis and in young patients after high-energy trauma. Types include femoral neck, intertrochanteric, and subtrochanteric fractures. Treatment usually requires surgical fixation or joint replacement.

#### Synonyms:

Hip fracture

### Fracture, Leg

A break in the tibia (shinbone), fibula, or both bones of the lower leg. Caused by direct trauma, sports injuries, or falls. Symptoms include pain, swelling, deformity, and inability to bear weight. Treatment depends on fracture pattern and stability.

#### Synonyms:

Broken leg

### Fracture, Stress

A partial or complete bone fracture caused by repetitive force or overuse, commonly affecting weight-bearing bones (metatarsals, tibia, femur). Athletes and military recruits are at increased risk. Presents with activity-related pain that worsens with continued activity.

#### Synonyms:

Stress fractures; fatigue fractures

### Fractured Nose

A break in the nasal bones or cartilage, usually caused by direct trauma. Symptoms include pain, swelling, epistaxis, and deformity. May be associated with septal hematoma requiring drainage. Treatment ranges from closed reduction to surgical repair.

#### Synonyms:

Broken nose; nasal fracture

### Fractured Rib

A break in one or more of the 12 pairs of ribs. Usually caused by trauma. Symptoms include sharp chest pain that worsens with breathing, coughing, or movement. May be associated with pneumothorax, hemothorax, or organ injury. Treatment is mainly supportive.

#### Synonyms:

Broken ribs; rib fracture

### Frontal Lobe Epilepsy

Seizures originating in the frontal lobe, characterized by motor symptoms, behavioral changes, or nocturnal events. Often occurs during sleep. Semiology depends on the specific frontal lobe region involved. May be refractory to medication.

#### Synonyms:

Frontal lobe seizures

### Fuchs Endothelial Corneal Dystrophy

A bilateral, progressive disorder in which corneal endothelial cells are lost and abnormal Descemet-membrane excrescences called guttae develop. Reduced endothelial fluid-pump function causes morning-predominant blurred vision, corneal edema, and, in advanced disease, painful epithelial bullae. It commonly becomes clinically significant in middle or older age, although early disease may be asymptomatic. Treatment ranges from monitoring and hypertonic measures to endothelial keratoplasty for visually disabling or painful disease.

#### Synonyms:

Fuchs dystrophy

### Fungal Infection, Nail

Onychomycosis: a fungal infection of the fingernails or toenails, causing discoloration, thickening, and brittleness. Most commonly caused by dermatophytes. Risk factors include age, diabetes, peripheral vascular disease, and immunosuppression. Treatment includes topical or oral antifungals.

#### Synonyms:

Onychomycosis; nail fungus



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## Funnel Chest

Pectus excavatum: a congenital chest wall deformity characterized by depression of the sternum and adjacent costal cartilages. Severity ranges from mild to severe. May cause cardiac or pulmonary compression in severe cases. Surgical correction is an option for symptomatic or severe deformity.

### Synonyms:

Pectus excavatum

## Face Pain

Pain in the facial region caused by dental, sinus, nerve, eye, joint, skin, vascular, or other disorders; pattern and associated signs guide evaluation.

## Face Powder Poisoning

Face powder poisoning involves exposure or injury from face powder poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

## Facial Nerve Palsy Due To Birth Trauma

Facial nerve palsy due to birth trauma concerns facial nerve palsy due to birth trauma, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Facial Swelling

Facial swelling is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

## Facial Tics

Sudden, repetitive, involuntary facial movements or sounds, such as blinking, grimacing, or nose wrinkling, commonly seen in tic disorders.

## Facial Trauma

Injury to the face involving skin, soft tissue, teeth, nerves, vessels, orbit, nose, or facial bones, requiring assessment of airway, vision, and structural damage.

## Facioscapulohumeral Muscular Dystrophy

An inherited muscular dystrophy causing progres-

sive weakness of facial, shoulder-blade, and upper-arm muscles, often with asymmetric onset and variable severity.

## Factitious Hyperthyroidism

A clinical condition or finding involving factitious hyperthyroidism. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Factor II (Prothrombin) Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor ii (prothrombin) assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Factor IX Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor ix assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Factor V Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor v assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Factor VII Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor vii assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Factor VII Deficiency

A clinical condition or finding involving factor vii deficiency. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Factor VIII Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor viii assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Factor X Assay

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor x assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

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### **Factor X Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving factor x deficiency. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Factor XII (Hageman Factor) Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving factor xii (hageman factor) deficiency. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Factor XII Assay**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess factor xii assay. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Facts About Monounsaturated Fats**

A clinical condition or finding involving facts about monounsaturated fats. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Facts About Polyunsaturated Fats**

A clinical condition or finding involving facts about polyunsaturated fats. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Facts About Saturated Fats**

A clinical condition or finding involving facts about saturated fats. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Facts About Trans Fats**

A clinical condition or finding involving facts about trans fats. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Faltering Weight**

Inadequate weight gain or downward crossing of a child's growth trajectory, caused by insufficient intake, feeding difficulty, malabsorption, chronic disease, or psychosocial factors.

### **Familial Dysbetalipoproteinemia**

An inherited disorder of remnant lipoprotein clearance causing elevated cholesterol and triglycerides, palmar xanthomas, tuberous xanthomas, and premature atherosclerosis.

### **Familial Hypertriglyceridemia**

An inherited tendency toward elevated blood triglycerides, often worsened by obesity, diabetes, alcohol, or medicines and sometimes increasing pancreatitis risk.

### **Familial Lipoprotein Lipase Deficiency**

A rare autosomal-recessive disorder in which impaired triglyceride breakdown causes severe chylomicronemia, recurrent pancreatitis, eruptive xanthomas, and abdominal pain.

### **Family Troubles - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning family troubles - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Fast Food Tips**

A patient-care topic concerning fast food tips. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Fast Heart Rate - Tachycardia**

Fast heart rate - tachycardia concerns fast heart rate - tachycardia, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Febrile (Warm) And Cold Agglutinins**

Antibodies that cause red cells to clump at warmer or colder temperatures; clinically important forms can cause autoimmune hemolytic anemia.

### **Febrile Seizures**

Febrile seizures are seizures associated with fever in young children without evidence of central nervous system infection or prior unprovoked seizures.

#### **Synonyms:**

Children Seizures (Febrile Seizures) Seizure Febrile

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(Febrile Seizures) Seizure Fever Induced (Febrile Seizures)

### **Febrile Seizures - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient-care topic concerning febrile seizures - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Fecal Culture**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fecal culture. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fecal Fat**

Measurement or observation of excess fat in stool, suggesting impaired digestion or absorption from pancreatic, bile-acid, intestinal, or other disease.

### **Fecal Immunochemical Test (FIT)**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fecal immunochemical test (fit). Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fecal Microbiota Transplant**

Fecal microbiota transplantation transfers processed stool from a screened donor to restore intestinal microbial communities, particularly for recurrent *Clostridioides difficile* infection.

### **Fecal Smear**

Fecal smear concerns fecal smear, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Feeding Patterns And Diet - Babies And Infants**

A patient-care topic concerning feeding patterns and diet - babies and infants. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Feeding Patterns And Diet - Children 6 Months To 2 Years**

A patient-care topic concerning feeding patterns and

diet - children 6 months to 2 years. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Feeding Tube - Infants**

A clinical condition or finding involving feeding tube - infants. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Feeding Tube Insertion - Gastrostomy**

Feeding tube insertion - gastrostomy is a nutrition or dietary term; appropriate use depends on age, health status, allergies, intake, and medical treatment.

### **Female Condoms**

A flexible internal barrier placed in the vagina before sex that helps prevent pregnancy and reduces exposure to semen and some sexually transmitted infections.

### **Female Pattern Baldness**

Progressive scalp hair thinning in a typically female distribution, influenced by genetics and androgens; evaluation considers iron deficiency, thyroid disease, medicines, and other causes.

### **Femoral Hernia Repair**

Femoral hernia repair is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Femoral Nerve Dysfunction**

A biological or anatomical term referring to femoral nerve dysfunction. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Femur Fracture Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving femur fracture repair - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Fenoprofen Calcium Overdose**

Fenoprofen calcium overdose involves exposure or injury from fenoprofen calcium overdose; dose, route,

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timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Ferritin Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess ferritin blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fetal Development**

A clinical condition or finding involving fetal development. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fetal Scalp PH Testing**

Fetal scalp pH testing involves exposure or injury from fetal scalp pH testing; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Fetal-Maternal Erythrocyte Distribution Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fetal-maternal erythrocyte distribution blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fibrates**

A clinical condition or finding involving fibrates. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fibrin Degradation Products Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fibrin degradation products blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fibrinogen Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fibrinogen blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fibrinolysis - Primary Or Secondary**

A clinical condition or finding involving fibrinolysis - primary or secondary. Its defining features, causes,

evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fibrinopeptide A Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fibrinopeptide a blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fibroadenoma Of The Breast**

A common benign breast tumor composed of glandular and fibrous tissue, usually smooth, mobile, and painless, especially in adolescents and young adults.

### **Fine Motor Control**

The coordinated use of small muscles, especially in the hands and fingers, for precise tasks such as writing, buttoning, and manipulating objects.

### **Fine Needle Aspiration Of The Thyroid**

A procedure using a thin needle to remove thyroid cells for cytologic examination, usually guided by ultrasound to evaluate a nodule.

### **Finger Pain**

Finger pain is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Fingers That Change Color**

Fingers that change color concerns fingers that change color, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Fire Ants**

Stinging ants whose venom causes immediate burning pain and itchy sterile pustules; numerous stings can produce systemic allergic or toxic reactions.

### **Fire Safety At Home**

A patient-care topic concerning fire safety at home. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, manage-

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ment, and follow-up.

### **First Aid Kit**

A clinical condition or finding involving first aid kit. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fish Tapeworm Infection**

A clinical condition or finding involving fish tapeworm infection. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fishhook Removal**

Fishhook removal is a diagnostic, research, imaging, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### **Flat Bones**

Flat bones concerns flat bones, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Fleas**

A clinical condition or finding involving fleas. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluorescein Eye Stain**

A clinical condition or finding involving fluorescein eye stain. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fluoride In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning fluoride in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Fluoride Overdose**

Fluoride overdose involves exposure or injury from fluoride overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Flushable Reagent Stool Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess flushable reagent stool blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Focal Neurologic Deficits**

Loss of a specific neurologic function, such as strength, sensation, language, vision, or coordination, caused by a localized brain, spinal-cord, or nerve lesion.

### **Folic Acid - Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess folic acid - test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Folic Acid And Birth Defect Prevention**

A patient-care topic concerning folic acid and birth defect prevention. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Folic Acid In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning folic acid in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Follicle-Stimulating Hormone (FSH) Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess follicle-stimulating hormone (fsh) blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Fontanelles - Bulging**

A tense or outwardly bulging soft spot on an infant's skull when calm and upright, potentially indicating raised intracranial pressure or meningitis.

### **Fontanelles - Enlarged**

Soft spots on an infant's skull that are larger than expected, associated with normal variation, prematurity, hypothyroidism, rickets, or increased intracranial pressure.

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### **Fontanelles - Sunken**

Depression of an infant's soft spot, commonly suggesting dehydration or reduced intracranial volume when assessed with the child calm and upright.

### **Food Additives**

Substances intentionally added to food for preservation, flavor, color, texture, or stability; reactions and safety depend on the additive and exposure.

### **Food Jags**

A child's persistent preference for a very small number of foods or refusal of previously accepted foods, common in development but concerning when nutrition or growth suffers.

### **Food Labeling**

Information on packaged food describing ingredients, allergens, serving size, nutrients, calories, and claims to support informed dietary choices.

### **Food Poisoning Prevention**

Food poisoning prevention involves exposure or injury from food poisoning prevention; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Foods - Fresh Vs. Frozen Or Canned**

Nutrition guidance comparing fresh, frozen, and canned foods; nutrient value depends on processing, storage, added sodium or sugar, and preparation.

### **Foot Amputation - Discharge**

Foot amputation - discharge is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Foot Sprain - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning foot sprain - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Foot, Leg, And Ankle Swelling**

Foot, leg, and ankle swelling is an anatomical, cellular,

developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Foraminotomy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to foraminotomy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Foreign Body In The Nose**

An object lodged in a nasal passage, often in a child, causing unilateral blockage, discharge, bleeding, odor, or tissue injury and requiring safe removal.

### **Foreign Object - Inhaled**

Foreign object - inhaled involves exposure or injury from foreign object - inhaled; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Foreign Object - Swallowed**

Foreign object - swallowed involves exposure or injury from foreign object - swallowed; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Foxglove Poisoning**

Foxglove poisoning involves exposure or injury from foxglove poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### **Fractured Clavicle In The Newborn**

A clinical condition or finding involving fractured clavicle in the newborn. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Free T4 Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess free t4 test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.



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### Frequent Or Urgent Urination

Increased need to urinate or sudden difficult-to-defer urges, caused by infection, bladder irritation, diabetes, medicines, pregnancy, obstruction, or overactive bladder.

### Frozen Shoulder - Aftercare

A patient-care topic concerning frozen shoulder - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### FTA-ABS Blood Test

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess fta-abs blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### Fuel Oil Poisoning

Fuel oil poisoning involves exposure or injury from fuel oil poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### Full Liquid Diet

A patient-care topic concerning full liquid diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### Funnel-Web Spider Bite

Funnel-web spider bite involves exposure or injury from funnel-web spider bite; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### Furniture Polish Poisoning

Furniture polish poisoning involves exposure or injury from furniture polish poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and tissue involvement determine the urgency and treatment approach.

### Ossicular Fusion

Abnormal joining or fixation of the middle-ear ossicles (malleus, incus, or stapes), which can restrict sound transmission and cause conductive hearing loss. Evaluation and treatment depend on the underlying congenital, inflammatory, traumatic, or

postoperative cause.

### Fusion Of The Ear Bones

Alternate descriptive label; see *Ossicular fusion*.

### Fussy Or Irritable Child

A clinical condition or finding involving fussy or irritable child. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Factitious Disorders

Factitious disorder involves deliberately producing or falsifying illness behavior to assume the sick role, without an obvious external reward. It is a mental-health disorder requiring nonjudgmental assessment, protection from unnecessary procedures, and coordinated psychiatric and medical care.

### Felty's Syndrome

Felty syndrome is a rare complication of long-standing seropositive rheumatoid arthritis characterized by neutropenia and often an enlarged spleen. It increases infection risk and may require disease-modifying therapy, growth factors, antibiotics, or specialist treatment.

### Female Reproductive System

The female reproductive system includes the ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, cervix, vagina, vulva, and related hormonal pathways. It supports ovulation, menstruation, pregnancy, birth, and sexual function and is affected by developmental, endocrine, infectious, and structural disorders.

### Fever And Headache

Fever with headache may occur with viral illness, influenza, sinus disease, dehydration, meningitis, encephalitis, or other infection. Severe sudden headache, neck stiffness, confusion, rash, seizure, weakness, or reduced consciousness requires emergency assessment.

### Fibrocystic Breast Condition

Fibrocystic breast change causes lumpiness, tenderness, or cysts that often vary with the menstrual

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cycle. It is usually benign, but a new persistent or changing mass, skin or nipple change, or bloody discharge needs clinical and imaging assessment.

### **Fibromyalgia Facts**

Fibromyalgia is a chronic pain-amplification disorder with widespread pain, fatigue, unrefreshing sleep, cognitive symptoms, and sensitivity to stimuli. Diagnosis is clinical after considering other causes; exercise, sleep treatment, education, psychological therapy, and selected medicines can help.

### **Flea Bites In Humans**

Flea bites cause small itchy papules, often clustered around the ankles or lower legs, and may trigger allergic reactions. Fleas can transmit infections in some settings; control requires treating pets and the environment as well as symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bites Flea (Flea Bites In Humans) Ctenocephalides FelFlea Bite (Flea Bites In Humans)

### **Freckles**

Freckles are small flat areas of increased melanin that darken with ultraviolet exposure and often reflect genetic tendency. They are usually harmless, but a changing, bleeding, irregular, or distinctly different pigmented lesion should be examined.

### **Friedreichs Ataxia Syndrome**

Friedreich ataxia is an inherited neurodegenerative disorder, usually autosomal recessive, caused by reduced frataxin and mitochondrial dysfunction. It causes progressive gait and limb ataxia, neuropathy, scoliosis, cardiomyopathy, and sometimes diabetes.

### **F (Symbol)**

A symbol that commonly means female, force, or Fahrenheit in medical records; the intended meaning depends on the surrounding context.

### **Failure To Thrive (FTT)**

Inadequate physical growth or unexpected weight loss, most often used for children with poor weight gain and sometimes for adults with functional decline; evaluation seeks nutritional, medical, develop-

mental, and social causes.

### **Fainting (Syncope)**

A brief loss of consciousness and postural tone caused by temporary inadequate blood flow to the brain, followed by spontaneous recovery; cardiac causes require urgent assessment.

### **False Labor**

Uterine contractions that may be uncomfortable but do not produce progressive cervical dilation and effacement; they are often irregular and may lessen with rest or hydration.

### **Familial**

Occurring in a family more often than expected, because of shared genes, environment, or both; familial does not necessarily mean a single-gene inherited disorder.

### **Familial Mediterranean Fever (FMF)**

An inherited autoinflammatory disorder, usually related to variants in *MEFV*, causing recurrent attacks of fever and inflammation of the abdominal, chest, or joint linings; amyloidosis is a possible complication.

### **Family Therapy**

Family therapy is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Fart**

A colloquial term for passing intestinal gas through the anus, produced from swallowed air and bacterial fermentation in the digestive tract.

### **Fasting Blood Glucose**

The blood glucose concentration measured after a period without caloric intake, usually at least 8 hours; it is used to screen for and diagnose disorders such as diabetes.

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## **FCC**

In medicine, an abbreviation for familial colorectal cancer; in other contexts it may have nonmedical meanings.

## **FDA**

Abbreviation for the United States Food and Drug Administration, the federal agency that regulates the safety, effectiveness, labeling, and security of many foods, medicines, biologics, and medical devices.

## **Fear Of Age**

An excessive or persistent fear of growing old or of older people, sometimes called gerontophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Children**

An excessive or persistent fear of children, sometimes called pedophobia, that causes significant distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Crossing Streets**

An excessive fear of crossing streets or roads, sometimes called agyrophobia, that may lead to marked avoidance and interfere with daily activities.

## **Fear Of Demons**

An excessive or persistent fear of demons or evil supernatural beings, sometimes called demonophobia.

## **Fear Of Drinking Alcohol**

An excessive or persistent fear of drinking alcoholic beverages, sometimes called methyphobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Dust**

An excessive or persistent fear of dust, sometimes called amatophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Feces**

An excessive or persistent fear of feces or defecation, sometimes called coprophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Fur**

An excessive or persistent fear of fur, sometimes called doraphobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Heat**

An excessive or persistent fear of heat, sometimes called thermophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Nudity**

An excessive or persistent fear of being naked or seeing others naked, sometimes called gymnophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Oneself**

An excessive or persistent fear of oneself or one's own thoughts or actions, sometimes called autophobia in some usage, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Fear Of Worms (Parasitic)**

An excessive or persistent fear of parasitic worms, sometimes called helminthophobia, that causes distress or avoidance.

## **Feedback**

Information about a system's output that influences subsequent activity; negative feedback helps stabilize physiology, while positive feedback amplifies a process.

## **Female Gonad**

An ovary, the female reproductive gland that produces oocytes and hormones such as estrogen and progesterone.

## **Female Pelvis**

The bony pelvis and associated soft tissues in a person with typical female pelvic anatomy; it is generally broader and has a wider pelvic outlet than the typical male pelvis, with substantial individual variation.

## **Female Urethral Opening**

The external urethral meatus, the opening through which urine leaves the female urethra, located in

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the vulvar vestibule anterior to the vaginal opening.

### **Femoral**

Relating to the femur or thigh, including the femoral artery, vein, nerve, and neck of the femur.

### **Fetishism**

A recurrent sexual interest in a nonliving object or a specific non-genital body part; it is a disorder only when it causes clinically significant distress or impairment or involves harm or lack of consent.

### **Fetoscope**

An instrument used to hear or assess the fetal heart-beat through the pregnant person's abdominal wall, especially later in pregnancy.

### **Fever, Shin Bone**

The shin bone is the tibia, the larger weight-bearing bone of the lower leg; fever is a separate term meaning an elevated body temperature, so this dictionary label appears to combine two concepts.

### **FFI**

Abbreviation for fatal familial insomnia, a rare inherited prion disease causing progressively severe insomnia, autonomic dysfunction, and neurologic decline.

### **Fields Disease**

An extremely rare, apparently congenital neuromuscular disorder reported in identical twins, characterized by progressive muscle degeneration and involuntary movements; its cause and natural history remain uncertain.

### **Filial**

Relating to a son or daughter, or to the relationship between offspring and a parent; in genetics, a filial generation is a generation descended from a parental generation.

### **Filler**

A material injected or placed beneath the skin or in tissue to restore volume, smooth lines, alter con-

tours, or replace lost structure; effects and risks depend on the material and site.

### **Finger Stick**

A small puncture of a fingertip used to obtain capillary blood, commonly for point-of-care glucose or other blood testing.

### **Fingernail**

The hard keratin plate covering the dorsal end of a finger, produced by the nail matrix and protecting the fingertip.

### **FISH**

Abbreviation for fluorescence in situ hybridization, a test that uses fluorescent DNA probes to detect specific genes, chromosomes, or chromosomal rearrangements in cells.

### **Fissure**

A narrow crack, groove, or cleft in a body structure; an anal fissure is a painful tear in the lining of the anal canal.

### **Fistula, Anal**

An abnormal tunnel connecting the anal canal or rectum with the nearby skin, often developing after an anorectal abscess and causing drainage or recurrent infection.

### **Fixation, Internal**

Surgical stabilization of a fractured or unstable bone with implanted devices such as plates, screws, rods, or pins.

### **Flank**

The side of the body between the lower ribs and the hip, overlying part of the abdomen and back; flank pain may arise from the kidney, muscles, spine, or other structures.

### **FLAP**

Abbreviation for 5-lipoxygenase-activating protein, a protein encoded by *ALOX5AP* that helps produce leukotrienes involved in inflammation.

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## Flashing

The perception of brief flashes or streaks of light without an external light source, often called photopsia; new flashes with floaters or visual-field loss require urgent eye assessment.

## Floater

A spot, strand, or cobweb-like shape drifting across the field of vision, usually caused by opacities in the eye's vitreous; sudden numerous floaters may signal retinal disease.

## Floating Rib

One of the eleventh or twelfth pairs of ribs, attached posteriorly to the spine but lacking an attachment to the sternum through cartilage.

## Floppy Baby Syndrome

A descriptive term for infant hypotonia, characterized by reduced muscle tone and a limp posture; causes range from central nervous-system disorders to neuromuscular and genetic diseases and require evaluation.

## Flora

The microorganisms normally or currently living in a body site or environment; normal flora can protect against pathogens but may cause infection if displaced or if defenses are impaired.

## Flush

A sudden reddening or warm sensation of the skin from increased blood flow, or the act of washing a body passage or intravenous line with fluid; context determines the meaning.

## Flutter

A rapid, regular, repetitive movement or contraction; atrial flutter is a cardiac arrhythmia caused by a rapid organized atrial circuit.

## Focal Sclerosis

Localized hardening or scarring of tissue; in the kidney, focal segmental glomerulosclerosis is a pattern of scarring affecting some glomeruli and parts of

affected glomeruli.

## FODMAPs

Fermentable oligosaccharides, disaccharides, monosaccharides, and polyols: short-chain carbohydrates that may be poorly absorbed and produce gas, bloating, pain, or diarrhea in susceptible people.

## Fomentation

The application of warm, moist material to a body part, traditionally to soothe pain, relax muscles, or promote local blood flow.

## Fontanel (Fontanelle)

A soft membranous gap between the skull bones of an infant, allowing skull growth and molding during birth; a bulging or markedly sunken fontanel can signal illness.

## Food And Drug Administration

The United States federal agency responsible for regulating the safety, effectiveness, manufacturing, labeling, and distribution of many foods, medicines, biologics, and medical devices.

## Food Poisoning, *Campylobacter*

Foodborne infection caused by *Campylobacter* bacteria, usually producing diarrhea, abdominal cramps, fever, and sometimes bloody stool; severe or persistent illness may require medical care.

## Foreign Body Airway Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of the nose, throat, or lower airway by an inhaled object or material; complete obstruction is a life-threatening choking emergency.

## Forensic

Relating to the application of scientific or medical knowledge to questions of law, investigation, or court proceedings.

## Forensic Genetics

The use of genetic testing and DNA analysis to iden-

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tify individuals, establish biological relationships, or investigate evidence in legal and criminal cases.

### **Formalin**

An aqueous solution of formaldehyde, commonly used to preserve biological tissue; it is toxic and irritating and must be handled with appropriate safety controls.

### **Formulary**

A list of medicines approved or preferred for use by a health system, insurer, or institution, often including prescribing restrictions and coverage information.

### **Fourth Disease**

An older name for Dukes' or Filatov–Dukes disease, a rash illness attributed to toxin-producing *Staphylococcus aureus*; the historical label has been debated and is not commonly used in modern diagnosis.

### **Freckle**

A small, flat, light-brown or tan area of increased skin pigmentation, often becoming more apparent with ultraviolet exposure; a changing pigmented lesion should be assessed.

### **French Disease**

A historical name for syphilis, a sexually transmitted infection caused by the bacterium *Treponema pallidum*.

### **Frequency, Urinary**

The need to urinate more often than usual, sometimes with only small amounts passed; causes include infection, irritation, pregnancy, diuretics, and disorders of the bladder or prostate.

### **Frontal**

Relating to the forehead or the frontal bone and frontal lobe of the brain.

### **Ft.**

Abbreviation for foot or feet, a unit of length equal to 12 inches or approximately 30.48 centimeters; in

clinical notes, context should distinguish it from other abbreviations.

### **FTA-Abs Test**

Fluorescent treponemal antibody absorption test, a blood test that detects antibodies against *Treponema pallidum* and supports evaluation of syphilis; antibodies may remain detectable after treatment.

### **Fundus, Retinal**

The inside back surface of the eye seen during ophthalmoscopy, including the retina, optic disc, macula, and retinal blood vessels.

### **Fungal**

Relating to fungi or caused by a fungus; fungal infections may affect the skin, nails, mucous membranes, lungs, or other organs.

### **Fusiform**

Shaped like a spindle, wider in the middle and tapering toward both ends; the term can describe a swelling, muscle, cell, or blood-vessel abnormality.

### **Fusospirochetal Gingivitis**

A severe form of gingival inflammation, traditionally associated with fusobacteria and spirochetes, causing painful swollen or bleeding gums, ulceration, and foul breath; it is also called acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis.

### **Functional Neurologic Disorder/Conversion Disorder**

Neurologic symptoms such as weakness, abnormal movement, seizures, or sensory changes that are not explained by structural neurologic disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Conversion Disorder

### **Frontal Lobe Seizures**

Seizures beginning in the frontal lobes of the brain, often causing brief unusual movements, behaviors, sensations, or impaired awareness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Epilepsy, Frontal Lobe



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## Formed Elements Of Blood

The cellular components of blood: red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets.

## Facial Spasm

Facial Spasm is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

## Facioscapulohumeral Dystrophy

Facioscapulohumeral Dystrophy is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Faecal Fistula

Faecal Fistula is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Faeces

Faeces is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

## Fallopian Tubes

Fallopian Tubes is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

## Fallot's Tetralogy

Fallot's Tetralogy is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Falls

Falls is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## False Passages

A clinical condition or finding involving false pas-

sages. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Familial Hypercholesterolaemia

Familial Hypercholesterolaemia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Fasciolopsis

A clinical condition or finding involving fasciolopsis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Fatal Familial Insomnia

Fatal Familial Insomnia is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Fat-Soluble Vitamins

Fat-Soluble Vitamins is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Favus

Favus is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Fears

Fears is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

## Febrile Convulsions

Febrile Convulsions is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Fecolith

A clinical condition or finding involving fecolith. Its

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defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Feedback Mechanism**

Feedback Mechanism is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Feingold Diet**

Feingold Diet is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Felon**

Felon is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Female Circumcision**

Female Circumcision is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Femoral Pulse**

Femoral Pulse is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Fertile Period**

Fertile Period is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Fertility Drugs**

Fertility Drugs is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Festinating Gait**

A clinical condition or finding involving festinating gait. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fetal Monitoring**

Fetal Monitoring is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fetal Monitoring, Electronic**

Fetal Monitoring, Electronic is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fibre**

Fibre is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fibrocystic Breast Disease**

Fibrocystic Breast Disease is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fibroids**

Fibroids is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fibromyalgi**

Fibromyalgi is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fibrositis**

Fibrositis is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Field Fever**

Field Fever is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features,

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investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Filum Terminale**

Filum Terminale is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Filterable Virus**

Filterable Virus is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Filtering Operations**

Filtering Operations is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Filtration**

Filtration is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fimbria**

Fimbria is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Fish-Handler's Disease**

Fish-Handler's Disease is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fisher's Syndrome**

Fisher's Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fish Poisoning**

Fish Poisoning is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or

clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fit**

Fit is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Flanged Needle**

A clinical condition or finding involving flanged needle. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Flap Operation**

Flap Operation is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Flea Bites**

A clinical condition or finding involving flea bites. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Flesh-Eating Bug**

Flesh-Eating Bug is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Flexor**

Flexor is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Flibanserin**

A clinical condition or finding involving flibanserin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Floating Kidney**

Floating Kidney is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

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## Florida Flu

Florida Flu is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Flotation

Flotation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## Floppy Iris Syndrome

Floppy Iris Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Flucloxacillin

Flucloxacillin is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Fluke

Fluke is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Flunarizine

Flunarizine is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Flunisolid

Flunisolid is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Fluocinolone

Fluocinolone is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, con-

traindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Fluocortolone

Fluocortolone is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Fluoridation

Fluoridation is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Flupentixol

Flupentixol is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Flux

Flux is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Foetal Alcohol Syndrome

Foetal Alcohol Syndrome is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

## Foetus

Foetus is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

## Folinic Acid

Folinic Acid is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

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### **Follicle-Stimulating Hormone (FSH)**

Follicle-Stimulating Hormone (FSH) is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Food Hygiene**

Food Hygiene is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Food Supplement**

Food Supplement is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Foot And Mouth Disease**

Foot and Mouth Disease is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Forced Expiratory Volume (FEV)**

Forced Expiratory Volume (FEV) is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Formula Feed**

Formula Feed is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Formula, Infant**

Formula, Infant is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Formulae**

Formulae is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends

on method and context.

### **Forssman Antigen**

Forssman Antigen is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fortified Wine**

Fortified Wine is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Fossula**

Fossula is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Fossus**

Fossus is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Fourchette**

Fourchette is an anatomical, developmental, reproductive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Fourth Venereal Disease**

Fourth Venereal Disease is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Framboesia**

A clinical condition or finding involving framboesia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fraternal Twins**

Fraternal Twins is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

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### **Freedman Test**

Freedman Test is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Frei's Test**

Frei's Test is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Frenulum**

Frenulum is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Frenum**

Frenum is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

### **Frequency Of Urination**

Frequency of Urination is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Freudian Slip**

A clinical condition or finding involving freudian slip. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Freudism**

A clinical condition or finding involving freudism. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Friable**

A clinical condition or finding involving friable. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Friction**

Friction is an anatomical, developmental, reproduc-

tive, nutritional, behavioral, or healthcare concept used in medical assessment or care.

### **Frigidity**

Frigidity is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Frog Test**

Frog Test is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

### **Fructose Intolerance**

Fructose Intolerance is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Fruitarian**

A clinical condition or finding involving fruitarian. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Fruity Breath**

Fruity Breath is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fugue**

Fugue is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.

### **Fulminant**

Fulminant is a disease, syndrome, symptom, or clinical finding; its causes, distinguishing features, investigation, and treatment depend on the patient and severity.



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## **Fumigation**

Fumigation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## **Fundoscopy**

Fundoscopy is a diagnostic test, physiologic measurement, procedure, or laboratory concept used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on method and context.

## **Fungicide**

Fungicide is a medicine, drug, vitamin, or chemical product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## **Fungoid**

Fungoid is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## **Funiculus**

Funiculus is a muscle, nerve, vessel, reproductive structure, or other body part; its location and function determine its clinical relevance.

## **First-Degree Heart Block**

Delay in conduction from the atria to the ventricles, shown on ECG by a prolonged but constant PR interval greater than 200 milliseconds. It is often asymptomatic, but the cause, medications, associated conduction disease, and progression risk should be assessed.

## **Fulminant Myocarditis**

A rapidly progressive form of myocarditis causing severe ventricular dysfunction, cardiogenic shock, or life-threatening arrhythmias. It requires urgent intensive-care assessment and treatment of shock and arrhythmias; temporary mechanical circulatory support may be needed while myocardial function recovers or definitive therapy is arranged.

## **Flexural**

Relating to a skin fold or the inner surface of a joint, such as the antecubital, popliteal, axillary, groin, or inframammary fold.

## **Follicular**

Relating to or centered on a hair follicle; follicular lesions may appear as papules, pustules, keratotic plugs, or inflammation around hairs.

## **Fungating**

Describing a mass or lesion that grows outward with an irregular, ulcerated, necrotic, or malodorous surface, commonly in advanced malignancy or severe chronic wounds.

## **Fibroproliferation**

Abnormal proliferation of fibroblasts and deposition of connective tissue that contributes to scarring and fibrosis, including in the lungs.

## **Flumazenil**

A benzodiazepine-receptor antagonist that can reverse benzodiazepine sedation or respiratory depression in selected cases; it may precipitate seizures or withdrawal and is not appropriate for every mixed overdose.

## **Fallopian-Tube Endometriosis**

Endometrial-type glands and stroma within or around the fallopian tube, which may cause pelvic pain, infertility, adhesions, or an incidental pathologic finding.

## **Paratubal Cyst**

A usually benign fluid-filled cyst adjacent to the fallopian tube, arising from paratubal or embryologic remnants; most are asymptomatic but large cysts may cause pain or torsion.

## **Serous Tubal Intraepithelial Carcinoma (STIC)**

A noninvasive high-grade serous lesion of the fallopian-tube fimbria, considered a precursor or early manifestation of many tubo-ovarian high-grade

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serous carcinomas.

### **Fibroma Of Tendon Sheath**

A benign, slow-growing fibroblastic tumor attached to a tendon sheath, most often affecting the fingers, hand, or wrist. It presents as a firm painless mass and may recur after excision.

### **Fibromatoses**

A group of locally infiltrative fibroblastic proliferations that lack metastatic potential but may recur and damage adjacent structures; superficial and deep types are distinguished clinically and pathologically.

### **Fibroepithelial Polyp Of The Vulva**

A benign polypoid lesion composed of stellate stromal cells beneath squamous epithelium, often arising in the vulvovaginal region during reproductive years or pregnancy.

### **Facial Nerve Palsy**

Weakness or paralysis of muscles supplied by the seventh cranial nerve, causing facial asymmetry and difficulty closing the eye or moving the mouth. It may be idiopathic, infectious, inflammatory, traumatic, neoplastic, or vascular in origin. Sudden onset requires assessment for stroke and other neurologic emergencies, especially when limb weakness, speech disturbance, or sensory loss is present. Evaluation and treatment depend on the pattern, severity, cause, and risk of ocular or neurologic complications.

### **Farmer's Lung**

Hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhalation of antigens from moldy hay, grain, or other agricultural materials. Repeated exposure produces immune-mediated inflammation of the distal airways and lung interstitium. Acute disease may cause fever, cough, chills, and dyspnea several hours after exposure, whereas chronic disease may cause progressive fibrosis. Diagnosis combines exposure history, imaging, pulmonary-function testing, and specialist assessment; avoidance of the antigen is central to management.

### **Fusarium Infection**

An opportunistic infection caused by *Fusarium* species, environmental molds that can produce keratitis, onychomycosis, or invasive disease. Invasive infection occurs mainly in people with severe neutropenia, hematologic malignancy, transplantation, or other major immunosuppression. Skin lesions, sinus or lung disease, and bloodstream infection may occur, with dissemination to multiple organs in severe cases. Diagnosis requires culture or histopathology with species-level evaluation when possible; treatment requires urgent specialist antifungal management and correction of immunosuppression when feasible.

## G

### G-Protein Coupled Receptors

The largest family of cell surface receptors with seven transmembrane alpha-helical domains. Upon ligand binding, the receptor undergoes a conformational change that activates an associated heterotrimeric G-protein (G $\alpha$ , G $\beta$ , G $\gamma$ ). The G $\alpha$  subunit exchanges GDP for GTP and dissociates from the G $\beta$ -gamma complex.

### Gain

The amount by which a hearing aid increases sound intensity, measured in decibels.

### Gait Cycle

The sequence of leg and foot movements from one heel strike to the next heel strike of the same foot.

### Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid

The principal inhibitory neurotransmitter in the brain.

**Synonyms:**  
GABA

### Gastric

Relating to the stomach.

### Gastrointestinal

Relating to the digestive system.

**Synonyms:**  
GI

### Generic Drug

A medicine equivalent to a brand-name medicine in active ingredient, strength, dosage form, and intended use, usually sold under a nonproprietary

name.

**Synonyms:**  
Generic medicine

### Genetic

Relating to genes, heredity, or inherited characteristics.

### Genistein

A soy-derived isoflavone with estrogen-like and antioxidant activity.

### GERD

Gastroesophageal reflux disease, in which stomach contents repeatedly flow back into the esophagus.

**Synonyms:**  
Gastroesophageal reflux disease

### Geriatric Care Manager

A professional who helps coordinate health and support services for an older adult.

**Synonyms:**  
Aging-life care manager

### GFR

Glomerular filtration rate, an estimate of how efficiently the kidneys filter blood.

**Synonyms:**  
Glomerular filtration rate

### Gingiva

The oral tissue surrounding and protecting the roots of the teeth.

**Synonyms:**  
Gums; gum tissue

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### **Gleason Score**

A grading system that estimates the aggressiveness of prostate cancer from its microscopic appearance.

**Synonyms:**

Gleason grade group

### **Glenoid**

The shallow socket of the scapula that forms the shoulder joint with the humeral head.

**Synonyms:**

Glenoid cavity

### **Glomeruli**

Microscopic capillary networks in the kidneys where blood filtration begins.

**Synonyms:**

Renal glomeruli

### **Glutamic Acid Decarboxylase**

An enzyme that converts glutamate to GABA; antibodies to it can occur in type 1 diabetes.

**Synonyms:**

GAD

### **Glycosylated Hemoglobin**

Hemoglobin with glucose attached, reflecting average blood glucose over roughly two to three months.

**Synonyms:**

Hemoglobin A1c; HbA1c

### **GnRH**

Gonadotropin-releasing hormone, which stimulates pituitary release of LH and FSH.

**Synonyms:**

Gonadotropin-releasing hormone

### **GnRH Antagonists**

Medicines that block GnRH signaling and reduce pituitary release of reproductive hormones.

### **Goblet Cells**

Specialized epithelial cells that secrete mucus, especially in the intestine and airways.

### **Gonadotropin-Releasing Hormone**

A hypothalamic hormone that controls pituitary secretion of FSH and LH.

**Synonyms:**

GnRH

### **Gram**

A metric unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a kilogram.

**Synonyms:**

g

### **Greenstick Fracture**

An incomplete fracture in which a young bone bends and cracks rather than breaking all the way through.

### **G Spot**

A proposed area of sexually sensitive tissue on the front wall of the vagina.

**Synonyms:**

Grafenberg spot

### **Guardianship**

A legal arrangement in which an appointed person makes decisions for someone unable to make them independently.

**Synonyms:**

Legal guardianship

### **Gullet**

The esophagus, the tube carrying food from the throat to the stomach.

**Synonyms:**

Esophagus

### **Gum Disease**

Inflammation or infection affecting the gums and supporting tissues of the teeth.

**Synonyms:**

Periodontal disease Periodontitis (Gum Disease)

### **Gums**

The soft oral tissue surrounding and supporting the teeth.

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**Synonyms:**

Gingiva

**G6PD Deficiency**

Glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase (G6PD) deficiency is an X-linked enzymopathy affecting the pentose phosphate pathway, leading to impaired NADPH production and reduced glutathione regeneration, rendering erythrocytes susceptible to oxidative hemolysis. Common variants: African A- (mild), Mediterranean (severe), Mahidol (SE Asia).

**GABA (Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid)**

The primary inhibitory neurotransmitter in the mammalian central nervous system, synthesised from glutamate via glutamic acid decarboxylase (GAD) with pyridoxal phosphate (vitamin B6) as cofactor.

**Synonyms:**

Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid

**Gadolinium-Based Contrast Agent**

A paramagnetic contrast agent used in MRI to alter tissue signal and improve lesion conspicuity or vascular assessment. Agent selection and dosing consider kidney function, pregnancy, prior reactions, and the rare risk of nephrogenic systemic fibrosis.

**Gadolinium-Induced Nephrogenic Systemic Fibrosis**

Rare but serious condition in patients with severe renal impairment receiving gadolinium-based MRI contrast. Causes skin thickening, organ fibrosis. Risk reduced with macrocyclic agents.

**Gagging**

A protective retching response triggered by stimulation of the pharynx, posterior tongue, or nearby structures. It may occur during swallowing, examination, aspiration, reflux, infection, or emotional distress; persistent gagging with dysphagia, vomiting, respiratory symptoms, or weight loss requires assessment.

**Gait**

The pattern or style of walking. Gait is a com-

plex motor function involving coordination of the central and peripheral nervous systems, muscles, and joints. Gait assessment evaluates stance, stride length, cadence, arm swing, truncal stability, and turning.

**Gait Abnormality**

A deviation from normal walking caused by musculoskeletal, neurological, vestibular, visual, cardiovascular, or systemic disease. Assessment considers speed, base, symmetry, balance, stride, turning, assistive-device use, and associated weakness, sensory loss, pain, or cognitive impairment.

**Gait Assessment**

A crucial component of the neurological examination that provides significant diagnostic information about the underlying neurological condition. Normal gait requires intact motor, sensory, cerebellar, and vestibular systems, as well as intact cognition.

**Gait Disturbance**

An abnormality of walking that may involve speed, balance, coordination, strength, or the pattern of movement. Causes include neurologic, musculoskeletal, vestibular, and systemic disorders.

**Gait Speed**

Walking velocity measured over a standardized distance. It is a simple marker of mobility, frailty, disability, and mortality risk and can track functional change over time.

**Gait Training**

Teaching or retraining walking pattern. Techniques: parallel bars, walker, cane, stair training. Addresses abnormalities: limping, antalgic gait, hemiplegic gait, parkinsonian gait. Goals: safety, efficiency, independence.

**Galactoceles**

A milk-filled retention cyst of the breast, occurring during lactation or after weaning. Results from obstruction of a milk duct. Presents as a painless, fluctuant breast mass. Diagnosis by ultrasound showing a well-defined, hypoechoic or anechoic mass.

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Treatment includes aspiration.

### **Galactagogue**

A substance that promotes breast milk production.

### **Galactorrhea**

Milk-like nipple discharge unrelated to breastfeeding or the period after childbirth. It may result from increased prolactin, medicines, pregnancy, endocrine disease, breast stimulation, or other conditions and requires assessment when persistent or unexplained.

### **Galactorrhoea**

The spontaneous flow of milk from the breast not associated with childbirth or breastfeeding. Galactorrhoea can be unilateral or bilateral and is caused by hyperprolactinaemia (elevated prolactin).

### **Galactosaemia**

A rare autosomal recessive disorder of galactose metabolism caused by deficiency of one of three enzymes: galactose-1-phosphate uridylyltransferase (GALT, classic galactosaemia, type I), galactokinase (GALK, type II), or UDP-galactose epimerase (GALE, type III).

### **Galactose Metabolism**

Conversion of galactose to glucose-1-phosphate through the Leloir pathway involving galactokinase, galactose-1-phosphate uridylyltransferase, and UDP-galactose 4-epimerase. Defects cause galactosemia, which can produce liver disease, cataracts, and developmental toxicity.

### **Galactosemia**

Galactosemia is an inherited inability to metabolize galactose, causing neonatal feeding problems, jaundice, liver injury, infection risk, and developmental complications without dietary treatment. galactose-1-phosphate uridylyltransferase deficiency. Untreated classic disease can cause jaundice, liver dysfunction, vomiting, cataracts, sepsis, and neurodevelopmental impairment after milk feeding.

### **Galant Reflex**

A primitive reflex present from birth to 4 months, elicited by stroking the skin along the side of the infant's back. The infant curves toward the stimulated side. Assessed by running a finger from the lateral back toward the hip while the infant is in ventral suspension. Absence may indicate neurologic abnormality.

### **Gall-Bladder**

A pear-shaped sac located beneath the liver on the visceral surface, in the gallbladder fossa between the right and quadrate lobes of the liver. Capacity: approximately 30-50 mL.

### **Gall-Bladder, Diseases Of**

Conditions affecting the gallbladder, including gallstones, inflammation, infection, polyps, and cancer. Symptoms and treatment depend on the specific disorder.

### **Gallavardin Phenomenon**

The dissociation of the murmur of aortic stenosis into two components: a musical quality heard at the apex and a harsh, rough quality heard at the right upper sternal border. This occurs because high-frequency components are transmitted to the apex while low-frequency components are heard at the base.

### **Gallbladder**

A small, pear-shaped sac under the liver that stores and concentrates bile before releasing it into the small intestine to aid fat digestion.

### **Gallbladder Cancer**

A malignant tumor arising in the gallbladder, often associated with chronic inflammation or gallstones. It may be discovered incidentally or present with abdominal pain, jaundice, or other biliary symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Gallbladder

### **Gallbladder Volvulus**

Axial torsion of the gallbladder around its mesen-



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tery and cystic duct, most commonly affecting elderly women, leading to acute gallbladder ischemia. Presents with sudden onset severe right upper quadrant pain, nausea, vomiting, and signs of peritoneal irritation.

### **Gallium Scan**

Nuclear medicine imaging using Ga-67. Detects inflammation, infection, tumors. Largely replaced by FDG-PET.

### **Gallium-68**

PET radionuclide, half-life 68 minutes. Produced from Ge-68/Ga-68 generator. Used in DOTATATE, PSMA, and other theranostic applications.

### **Gallstone Ileus**

Large gallstone eroding through the gallbladder wall into the duodenum causing mechanical small bowel obstruction. Diagnosed by CT showing Rigler triad of small bowel obstruction, pneumobilia, and ectopic gallstone. The most common site of obstruction is the ileum where the bowel caliber narrows.

### **Gallstones**

Gallstones are solid deposits in the gallbladder that may be asymptomatic or obstruct bile flow, causing biliary colic, cholecystitis, pancreatitis, or jaundice. obstruct the biliary tract, producing biliary pain, inflammation, jaundice, or pancreatitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cholelithiasis (Gallstones)

### **Gallstones (Cholelithiasis)**

Solid deposits that form in the gallbladder, usually from cholesterol or bile pigments. They may cause no symptoms or obstruct the biliary tract, producing biliary pain, inflammation, jaundice, or pancreatitis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cholelithiasis

### **Galvanism**

The application of a direct electric current for therapeutic or diagnostic purposes. Named after Luigi Galvani (1737-1798). Historical uses: galvanic stim-

ulation of muscles, iontophoresis (introduction of ionised drugs through skin), electroconvulsive therapy (modified).

### **Gambling Addiction**

A behavioral addiction characterized by persistent, difficult-to-control gambling despite harmful financial, social, occupational, or health consequences. It may involve preoccupation, increasing bets, unsuccessful attempts to stop, and gambling to escape distress. Assessment and structured behavioral and addiction treatment can help.

### **Gamma Camera**

Imaging device using NaI(Tl) scintillation crystal, photomultiplier tubes, collimator. Detects gamma rays from radiopharmaceuticals. Anger camera principle.

### **Gamma-Globulin**

A fraction of plasma proteins containing antibodies (immunoglobulins). Historically the term referred to a group of serum proteins with the slowest electrophoretic mobility (gamma region on serum protein electrophoresis). Currently synonymous with immunoglobulin preparations used for passive immunisation and immunotherapy.

### **Ganglion**

A collection of neuronal cell bodies located outside the central nervous system (CNS).

#### **Synonyms:**

Bible Cyst (Ganglion)

### **Ganglioneuroblastoma**

A neuroblastic tumor composed of mature ganglion cells and immature neuroblastic elements. Most often arises in the adrenal or paraspinal region and may present with an abdominal mass, pain, hypertension, or systemic symptoms. Intermediate between ganglioneuroma and neuroblastoma.

### **Ganglionic Blocker**

A class of drugs that block nicotinic acetylcholine receptors at autonomic ganglia (both sympathetic and parasympathetic), inhibiting neurotransmission

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in both divisions of the autonomic nervous system.

### **Gangrene**

Gangrene is tissue death caused by loss of blood supply, infection, or both; it can progress to systemic toxicity and requires urgent assessment of circulation and infection. bowel, and represents a form of coagulative necrosis. Dry gangrene occurs in tissues with gradual arterial occlusion, where the dead tissue becomes dry, shrunken, and dark brown or black.

### **Gargalesthesia**

The sensation of tickling. A complex sensory experience mediated by light tactile stimulation of sensitive skin areas (axillae, soles, flanks, ribcage). Involves both spinal reflexes (goosebumps, withdrawal) and emotional processing in the anterior cingulate cortex and somatosensory cortex.

### **Gargle**

The act of rinsing the mouth and throat with a liquid, holding it at the back of the throat while exhaling to create a bubbling action. Used for relief of sore throat or as a delivery method for antiseptics, anaesthetics, and anti-inflammatory agents.

### **Gartner Duct Cyst**

A benign cyst arising from remnants of the mesonephric (Wolffian) duct along the lateral wall of the vagina or uterus. They are typically asymptomatic and discovered incidentally on pelvic examination or imaging. Most require no treatment unless symptomatic, in which case surgical excision is performed.

### **Gas Gangrene**

A life-threatening infection in which bacteria produce toxins and gas within damaged tissue, causing rapid muscle destruction. It is commonly associated with *Clostridium* species and requires urgent surgical assessment, source control, and antimicrobial treatment.

### **Gaskin Maneuver (All-Fours Position)**

A maneuver for shoulder dystocia resolution: the

mother is rolled onto her hands and knees (all-fours position). Gravity and the change in pelvic dimensions (increased anteroposterior diameter of the pelvic outlet) may dislodge the impacted shoulder. The posterior arm may also be delivered more easily.

#### **Synonyms:**

All-Fours Position

### **Gastralgia**

Pain in the stomach or epigastric region.

### **Gastrectomy**

Surgical removal of all or part of the stomach. Indications: gastric cancer (most common), severe peptic ulcer disease, gastric lymphoma, gastrointestinal stromal tumor (GIST), perforation, bleeding. Types include total, partial, and laparoscopic gastrectomy.

### **Gastric Acid**

Hydrochloric acid secreted by gastric parietal cells, producing an intragastric pH of 1-3. Secretion is stimulated by histamine (H<sub>2</sub> receptors), gastrin (CCK-B/gastrin receptors), and acetylcholine (M<sub>3</sub> muscarinic receptors), and inhibited by somatostatin, prostaglandins, and luminal acid (negative feedback).

### **Gastric Bezoar**

Accumulation of indigestible material in the stomach. Phytobezoars consist of vegetable fiber, trichobezoars of hair, and pharmacobezoars of medications. Associated with gastroparesis, prior surgery, and impaired gastric motility. Diagnosed by endoscopy.

### **Gastric Bypass**

Roux-en-Y gastric bypass creating a small proximal pouch drained by a Roux limb, combining restrictive and mildly malabsorptive mechanisms. Indicated for BMI over 40, or over 35 with obesity-related comorbidity. Mean excess weight loss approaches 60-70 percent.

### **Gastric Cancer**

A malignant tumor arising from the stomach lining or other stomach tissue.

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## Gastric Carcinoid Tumor

Neuroendocrine tumor arising from enterochromaffin-like cells in the gastric fundus. Type I gastric carcinoids are associated with autoimmune atrophic gastritis and hypergastrinemia, are typically small and multifocal, and carry a good prognosis.

## Gastric Emptying

The movement of stomach contents into the duodenum through coordinated muscular contractions and pyloric regulation. Delayed emptying is called gastroparesis.

## Gastric Emptying Study

Nuclear medicine diagnostic test measuring the rate of gastric emptying. The protocol involves ingestion of a radiolabeled meal followed by serial gamma camera images obtained at one, two, and four hours. Gastric emptying is considered delayed if more than ten percent of the meal remains at four hours.

## Gastric Lymphoma

Malignant proliferation of lymphoid tissue in the stomach most commonly mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue lymphoma. Strongly associated with *H. pylori* infection. Early disease may regress completely with *H. pylori* eradication therapy alone.

## Gastric Malignancy

A cancerous tumor arising in the stomach.

## Gastric Outlet Obstruction

Blockage of gastric outflow at the pylorus or duodenum. Causes include peptic ulcer scarring, gastric cancer, and pyloric stenosis in infants. Presents with projectile vomiting, dehydration, and metabolic alkalosis. Diagnosis is by upper endoscopy and CT scan.

## Gastric Pneumatosis

Presence of gas within the gastric wall, also called gastric emphysema, which may be benign (gastric emphysema) or life-threatening (emphysematous gastritis). Benign forms result from barotrauma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, or mechani-

cal causes.

### Synonyms:

gastric emphysema, which may be.

## Gastric Polyps

Protruding lesions of the gastric mucosa classified by histological type. Fundic gland polyps are the most common type associated with long-term proton pump inhibitor use and familial adenomatous polyposis. Hyperplastic polyps are associated with chronic gastritis and *H. pylori* infection and carry a small risk of dysplasia.

## Gastric Surgery

Gastric cancer: D2 lymphadenectomy standard (stations 1-12a, 12b). Gastrectomy types: total, distal subtotal (Billroth I gastroduodenostomy, Billroth II gastrojejunostomy, Roux-en-Y), proximal, pylorus-preserving. Reconstruction: Roux-en-Y preferred (prevents bile reflux).

## Gastric Ulcer

Peptic ulcer in the gastric mucosa associated with *H. pylori*, NSAIDs, and smoking. Pain is typically worsened by food. There is a higher risk of malignancy than duodenal ulcers. Diagnosis is by upper endoscopy with biopsy to exclude malignancy.

## Gastric Volvulus

Rotation of the stomach along its axis causing obstruction. It may present with Borchardt triad of epigastric pain, retching, and inability to pass a nasogastric tube. It is a surgical emergency requiring decompression and gastropexy. Organoaxial volvulus is the most common type where the stomach rotates along its longitudinal axis.

## Gastrin

A peptide hormone produced by G cells in the gastric antrum and duodenum. Secreted in response to: (1) gastric distension, (2) amino acids and peptides (especially from protein-rich meals), (3) vagal stimulation (via gastrin-releasing peptide, GRP), (4) hypercalcaemia.

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## Gastrin Secretion

Gastrin is a peptide hormone produced by G-cells in the gastric antrum and duodenum, stimulating hydrochloric acid secretion by parietal cells, pepsinogen secretion by chief cells, and growth of the gastric mucosa.

## Gastrinoma

Gastrin-secreting neuroendocrine tumor causing Zollinger-Ellison syndrome characterized by gastric acid hypersecretion leading to severe peptic ulcer disease, diarrhea, and esophagitis. Approximately sixty percent are malignant with liver metastases. Multiple endocrine neoplasia type 1 association in approximately twenty percent.

## Gastritis

Gastritis is inflammation or injury of the stomach lining caused by infection, medications, alcohol, autoimmune disease, stress-related illness, or other factors.

## Gastrocnemius

The large superficial muscle of the posterior calf, forming the bulk of the calf contour. Origin: medial and lateral femoral condyles. Insertion: calcaneus via the Achilles tendon. Nerve: tibial nerve (S1-S2). Action: plantar flexion of the ankle (standing, walking, running, jumping); also flexes the knee.

## Gastrocnemius Muscle

Most superficial posterior leg muscle forming the calf prominence, with medial/lateral femoral condyle heads merging with soleus to form the Achilles tendon on the calcaneus. Innervated by tibial nerve (S1-S2). Plantarflexes ankle and flexes knee (two-joint muscle). Active in walking/running/jumping.

## Gastroduodenal Crohn Disease

Involvement of the stomach and duodenum by Crohn disease occurring in approximately five percent of patients with Crohn. Gastric Crohn typically involves the antrum and pylorus and can cause gastric outlet obstruction from edema, fibrosis, or stricture. Duodenal Crohn presents with epigastric pain, nausea, vomiting, and weight loss.

## Gastroenteritis

Inflammation of the stomach and intestinal mucosa, most commonly caused by viral infections (norovirus, rotavirus, adenovirus), bacterial pathogens (*E. coli*, *Salmonella*, *Campylobacter*), or parasites. Presents with diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal cramps, and dehydration. Self-limited in most cases.

## Gastroenterology

The medical specialty focused on the diagnosis and management of diseases of the gastrointestinal tract (esophagus, stomach, small intestine, colon, rectum, pancreas, gallbladder, bile ducts, liver). Subspecialties: hepatology (liver), pancreatology, inflammatory bowel disease, gastrointestinal oncology, neurogastroenterology.

## Gastroesophageal Junction Adenocarcinoma

A gland-forming cancer arising where the esophagus meets the stomach. Symptoms may include difficulty swallowing, reflux, weight loss, anemia, or bleeding. Diagnosis requires endoscopy and biopsy; treatment depends on stage and may include surgery, chemotherapy, radiation, immunotherapy, or targeted therapy.

## Gastroesophageal Reflux

Backward flow of gastric contents into the esophagus, caused by transient or persistent relaxation of the lower esophageal sphincter or other mechanical factors.

## Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease

A condition in which repeated reflux of stomach contents causes troublesome symptoms or complications. See Acid Reflux.

## Gastrogastic Intussusception

Rare form of intussusception where one segment of the stomach telescopes into an adjacent gastric segment, typically associated with a lead point such as a gastric polyp, leiomyoma, or carcinoma. Presents with abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, and occasionally upper gastrointestinal bleeding.

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### **Gastrografin Study**

X-ray imaging using water-soluble contrast. Used when barium contraindicated (perforation risk). Less detailed than barium.

### **Gastrointestinal Amyloidosis**

Deposition of misfolded amyloid fibrils in the gastrointestinal tract, either as part of systemic amyloidosis (AL, AA, or ATTR types) or rarely as primary localized disease.

### **Gastrointestinal Bleeding**

Hemorrhage from any part of the gastrointestinal tract classified as upper or lower based on location relative to the ligament of Treitz. Upper gastrointestinal bleeding originating proximal to this landmark typically presents with hematemesis or melena.

### **Gastrointestinal Bleeding Scan**

Detection of GI bleeding using Tc-99m labeled RBCs. Sensitive for active bleeding ( $>0.1$  mL/min). Localizes bleeding site. Alternative: tagged RBC scan, CT angiography.

### **Gastrointestinal Decontamination**

Methods: activated charcoal, gastric lavage (rare), whole bowel irrigation (sorbitol, PEG). Timing critical for charcoal (1-2 hours post-ingestion).

### **Gastrointestinal Obstruction**

Partial or complete blockage of the passage of intestinal contents through the gastrointestinal tract. It may be mechanical or functional and can cause colicky pain, vomiting, distention, constipation, obstipation, dehydration, bowel ischaemia, perforation, or sepsis.

### **Gastrointestinal Pain**

Pain arising from the digestive tract or related organs. Causes include indigestion, infection, ulcer disease, inflammation, obstruction, gallstones, and disorders of the liver or pancreas. Severe, persistent, or worsening pain requires medical assessment.

### **Gastrointestinal Perforation**

A full-thickness defect in the gastrointestinal wall allowing luminal contents to enter the peritoneal or adjacent space. It can cause peritonitis, sepsis, and shock and usually requires urgent imaging, antimicrobial therapy, resuscitation, and source control.

### **Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor**

A mesenchymal tumor arising from specialized cells in the gastrointestinal wall, most often in the stomach or small intestine. Many tumors contain activating changes in KIT or PDGFRA; their malignant potential varies.

### **Gastrointestinal Villi**

Finger-like projections of the small-intestinal mucosa that greatly increase absorptive surface area. Each villus contains blood capillaries and a central lacteal for transport of absorbed nutrients and lipids.

### **Gastroparesis**

Gastroparesis is delayed stomach emptying without mechanical obstruction, causing early satiety, nausea, vomiting, bloating, and poor glucose or nutritional control. mellitus, post-surgical changes, or idiopathic causes. Presents with nausea, vomiting of undigested food, early satiety, bloating, and abdominal pain. Diagnosed by gastric emptying scintigraphy showing more than ten percent retention at four hours.

#### **Synonyms:**

Delayed Gastric Emptying Delayed Gastric Emptying (Gastroparesis)

### **Gastroschisis**

Gastroschisis is a congenital full-thickness defect of the abdominal wall, usually beside the umbilicus, through which bowel or other viscera herniate without a protective sac. which bowel herniates without a covering membrane. Not associated with chromosomal abnormalities. Presents at birth with exposed bowel loops that may be edematous, thickened, and discolored from amniotic fluid exposure.



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## Gastrosplenic Fistulization

Abnormal communication between the stomach and spleen, most commonly arising from gastric ulcer erosion into the splenic hilum or as a complication of splenic abscess. Presents with abdominal pain, gastrointestinal hemorrhage, and sepsis.

## Gastrostomy

Surgical creation of an opening (stoma) through the abdominal wall into the stomach for enteral feeding or decompression.

## Gastrostomy Tube

Tube through abdominal wall into stomach for feeding. Percutaneous endoscopic gastrostomy. Indications: prolonged enteral feeding, dysphagia, neurological disorders. Complications: infection, leakage, granulation tissue, burial bumper.

## Gastrulation

A crucial early phase in embryonic development where the single-layered blastula reorganizes into a multi-layered structure with three germ layers.

## Gaucher Disease

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase, leading to lipid accumulation in cells and possible enlargement of the spleen and liver, anemia, bone disease, or neurologic disease.

### Synonyms:

Splénomégaly Gaucher (Gaucher Disease)

## Gaucher's Disease

Another name for Gaucher disease, an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase.

## Gauze

A woven or nonwoven material used to clean, dress, pack, or absorb fluid from a wound. It may be sterile or nonsterile and comes in several forms.

## Gavage

Feeding through a tube passed into the stomach

(nasogastric, orogastric, or gastrostomy tube). Used when oral feeding is impossible or inadequate. In neonates: gavage feeding is used for premature infants unable to coordinate suck-swallow-breathe.

## Gel

A semisolid pharmaceutical formulation in which a liquid (usually water) is immobilized within a three-dimensional network of a gelling agent (e.g., carbomer, cellulose, alginate).

## Gelfoam

An absorbable hemostatic agent made from purified porcine gelatin. Used in surgical settings to control bleeding where conventional hemostasis is difficult (liver, bone, neurosurgery). Mechanism: provides a physical matrix that promotes platelet aggregation and clot formation. Absorbed within 4-6 weeks.

## Gemfibrozil

A fibrate (PPAR-alpha agonist) used primarily for severe hypertriglyceridemia (reducing pancreatitis risk) and mixed hyperlipidemia. Raises HDL and lowers triglycerides markedly; modest LDL lowering.

## Gemination

Attempted division of single tooth bud. Results in large tooth with bifid crown, normal tooth count.

## Gender Dysphoria

Psychological distress resulting from incongruence between one's experienced gender and assigned gender at birth. Persists for  $\geq 6$  months and causes significant impairment. Onset in childhood (may resolve) or adolescence/adulthood (persistent).

## Gene

Basic unit of heredity, segment of DNA encoding a functional product (protein or RNA). Structure: promoter, coding sequence (exons), introns, terminator. Genes are located at specific positions (loci) on chromosomes.

## Gene Expression

Process by which information from a gene is used



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to synthesize functional product (protein or RNA). Steps: transcription, RNA processing, translation, post-translational modification. Regulated at multiple levels.

### Gene Panel

A laboratory test that sequences a selected group of genes associated with a clinical phenotype. Panels can provide efficient, focused analysis but may miss variants outside the selected genes or changes poorly detected by the platform.

### Gene Therapy

Treatment by introducing, removing, or changing genetic material. Approaches: gene addition (functional copy), gene silencing (siRNA, antisense), gene editing (CRISPR-Cas9). Examples: Luxturna (RPE65 mutation), Zolgensma (SMN1 in spinal muscular atrophy).

### General Anesthesia

A controlled, reversible state of unconsciousness, analgesia, amnesia, and muscle relaxation induced by pharmacologic agents, enabling surgical procedures without patient awareness or pain.

### General Anesthetic

An agent producing reversible loss of consciousness, amnesia, analgesia, and muscle relaxation sufficient for surgery.

### Generalized Anxiety Disorder

Characterized by excessive, difficult-to-control anxiety and worry about multiple events or activities occurring more days than not for at least six months. Associated symptoms include restlessness, being easily fatigued, difficulty concentrating, irritability, muscle tension, and sleep disturbance.

### Generalized Granuloma Annulare

A widespread variant of granuloma annulare presenting with numerous small, flesh-coloured to erythematous papules distributed over the trunk and extremities, lacking the classic annular arrangement of localized disease. It is often associated with diabetes mellitus and may be more persistent than

localized forms.

### Generalized Tonic-Clonic Seizure

A generalized tonic-clonic seizure (formerly grand mal seizure) is a seizure involving bilateral tonic stiffening followed by rhythmic clonic jerking of the extremities, with loss of consciousness.

### Generalized-Onset Seizure

A seizure that begins in bilaterally distributed networks and rapidly engages both cerebral hemispheres. Generalized absence, myoclonic, tonic, clonic, atonic, and tonic-clonic seizures are recognized clinical types.

### Generator

System for producing short-lived radionuclide from longer-lived parent. Tc-99m from Mo-99. Elution with saline. Quality control: Mo-99 breakthrough, Al-3+ breakthrough, sterility.

### Generic Medicine

A medicine containing the same active ingredient, strength, dosage form, route, and intended clinical effect as an approved reference product. Regulatory requirements generally include demonstration of pharmaceutical equivalence and bioequivalence.

### Genetic Counseling

Process of helping individuals understand and adapt to genetic aspects of disease. Includes risk assessment, education, psychosocial support, informed decision-making.

### Genetic Counselor

A health professional who evaluates inherited cancer risk, arranges and interprets genetic testing, and provides counseling to patients and families, including cascade testing of relatives.

### Genetic Heterogeneity

The occurrence of similar or related phenotypes caused by different genetic mechanisms. Locus heterogeneity refers to variants in different genes causing the same phenotype; allelic heterogeneity refers

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to different variants in the same gene.

### Genetic Screening

Testing of asymptomatic individuals for genetic disorders. Newborn screening: metabolic disorders, hemoglobinopathies. Carrier screening: before pregnancy or during pregnancy. Prenatal screening: non-invasive prenatal testing (NIPT), maternal serum screening.

### Genetic Sonogram

A targeted ultrasound performed at 18-22 weeks that combines standard anatomic survey with specific soft markers for aneuploidy.

### Genetic Testing

Analysis of DNA for disease risk or diagnosis. Examples: BRCA testing, carrier screening.

### Genetic Testing (Sequencing)

Analysis of the order of DNA bases to identify variants associated with genetic disorders. The method is selected according to the gene, variant, and clinical question.

#### Synonyms:

Sequencing

### Genetic Variant Of Uncertain Significance

A DNA variant for which available evidence is insufficient to classify it as benign or pathogenic. It should not generally be used alone to make predictive or treatment decisions and may be reclassified as evidence evolves.

### Genital Herpes

Herpes simplex virus infection of the genital region (HSV-2 most commonly; HSV-1 increasingly), transmitted sexually, causing painful grouped vesicles/ulcers, urethritis, dysuria, and lymphadenopathy; primary infection may cause fever and systemic symptoms. Recurrent episodes are shorter and milder.

### Genital Injury

Trauma to the genital or anogenital tissues caused by sexual contact, assault, childbirth, accident, or disease. Examination should document location, morphology, healing stage, pain, bleeding, and associated injuries without assuming mechanism from appearance alone.

### Genital Warts

Soft or rough growths on genital or perianal skin caused by infection with certain types of human papillomavirus.

#### Synonyms:

Condylomata Acuminata Venereal Warts Warts, Genital Warts, Venereal

### Genital Warts (Condylomata Acuminata)

Warts of the genital or anal region caused most often by low-risk types of human papillomavirus. They spread through direct skin-to-skin sexual contact and may be visible or asymptomatic.

#### Synonyms:

Condylomata Acuminata

### Genitalia

The external and internal reproductive organs. The term includes the vulva and vagina, or the penis, scrotum, and associated structures, together with the gonads and reproductive ducts when used broadly; anatomy varies with sex, age, and developmental stage.

### Genitals

The external and internal reproductive organs. Female genitals: external (vulva — mons pubis, labia majora, labia minora, clitoris, vaginal opening, Bartholin glands) and internal (vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries).

### Genito-Pelvic Pain/Penetration Disorder

A sexual dysfunction characterized by persistent or recurrent difficulties with vaginal penetration, marked vulvovaginal or pelvic pain during intercourse, fear or anxiety about penetration, and/or tensing of the pelvic floor muscles, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing marked distress.

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## Genodermatoses

Genetic skin disorders. Inherited ichthyoses (lamellar, X-linked, congenital ichthyosiform erythroderma). Epidermolysis bullosa (simplex, junctional, dystrophic). Neurocutaneous syndromes (neurofibromatosis, tuberous sclerosis, Sturge-Weber). Ectodermal dysplasias (hypohidrotic, hypotrichosis, nail dystrophy).

## Genomic Imprinting

Parent-of-origin-specific gene expression. Only one allele (maternal or paternal) is expressed. Examples: Prader-Willi (paternal deletion 15q11-q13), Angelman (maternal deletion 15q11-q13).

## Genotoxicity

The ability of a substance or physical agent to damage genetic material. Genotoxicity may cause mutations or chromosome damage, but a positive test does not by itself establish that an agent causes cancer in humans.

## Genotype

Genetic makeup of an individual, the specific alleles present at one or more loci. Determines phenotype along with environmental factors.

## Geographic Atrophy

The advanced form of dry age-related macular degeneration, characterized by well-demarcated, progressively enlarging areas of complete loss of the retinal pigment epithelium, choriocapillaris, and overlying photoreceptors in the macula, resulting in irreversible central vision loss.

## Geographic Tongue

Benign inflammatory condition of the tongue characterized by irregular red patches with white or yellow borders, alternating with areas of depapillation. Often asymptomatic and of unknown cause. May cause burning or irritation with certain foods.

### Synonyms:

Benign migratory glossitis Benign Migratory Glossitis

## Geriatric Assessment

Comprehensive multidimensional evaluation of elderly person. Domains: medical, functional, cognitive, psychological, social, environmental, pharmacological. Performed by interdisciplinary team. Guides care planning, identifies problems, predicts outcomes.

## Geriatric Dentistry

Dental care for elderly. Management of age-related changes, polypharmacy effects, xerostomia, root caries, periodontal disease, oral cancer screening.

## Geriatric Depression Scale

A screening questionnaire designed to detect depressive symptoms in older adults while minimizing emphasis on somatic symptoms that may overlap with medical illness. A positive screen requires clinical diagnostic assessment.

## Geriatric Medical Ethics

Ethical principles applied to care of older adults, including autonomy, capacity, beneficence, non-maleficence, and justice.

## Geriatric Nutrition

Nutrition care addressing the effects of aging, chronic disease, medications, frailty, oral and swallowing problems, sensory changes, and social factors on intake and nutritional status. Goals include preserving function, muscle mass, hydration, and quality of life.

## Geriatric Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation designed to improve function, mobility, independence, and safety in older adults after illness, injury, or functional decline.

## Geriatric Syndrome

Multifactorial condition common in elderly, not attributable to single disease. Examples: falls, incontinence, frailty, delirium, immobility, pressure ulcers. Require comprehensive assessment and multidisciplinary management.

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## Geriatrician

A physician specializing in the health care of older adults, including complex illness, multiple conditions, medications, function, and goals of care.

## Geriatrics

The medical specialty concerned with the health, function, and care of older adults.

## Germ

A colloquial term for a microorganism that causes disease.

## Germ Cell Tumor

A tumor arising from germ cells (precursors of sperm and eggs), including seminoma, dysgerminoma, teratoma, yolk sac tumor, embryonal carcinoma, and choriocarcinoma. Occurs in the testis, ovary, and extragonadal sites (mediastinum, retroperitoneum, pineal); many are highly curable with platinum-based chemotherapy.

## Germ Theory Of Disease

The scientific principle that specific microorganisms cause specific infectious diseases; established in the late 19th century by Koch (postulates—organism present in all cases, isolated in pure culture, reproduces disease when inoculated, re-isolated) and promoted by Pasteur and Lister.

## German Measles (Rubella)

A contagious viral infection caused by rubella virus, characterized by fever, lymph-node enlargement, and a fine rash. Infection during pregnancy can harm the fetus.

### Synonyms:

Rubella

## Germinoma

A germ-cell tumor most commonly arising in the pineal or suprasellar region, highly sensitive to radiation and chemotherapy. Ovarian (dysgerminoma) and testicular (seminoma) counterparts exist.

## Germline Mutation

A genetic variant present in the egg or sperm and therefore present in essentially every cell of the individual. Pathogenic germline variants may confer inherited cancer susceptibility and can have implications for relatives and treatment.

## Germline Testing

Genetic testing performed to identify inherited or potentially heritable variants, usually from blood or saliva. Results may affect the patient, biological relatives, cancer surveillance, reproductive planning, and genetic counseling.

## Germline Variant

A DNA variant present in the cells that give rise to eggs or sperm and therefore potentially transmissible to offspring. It may also be present in most cells of the individual, unlike a variant restricted to a somatic tissue.

## Gerontologist

A specialist who studies aging and its biological, psychological, social, or economic effects.

## Gerontology

The multidisciplinary study of aging and the biological, psychological, social, and environmental factors that influence it.

## Gestation

The period of development of a fetus from fertilization to birth. Human gestation averages 280 days (40 weeks) from the first day of the last menstrual period (LMP) or 266 days (38 weeks) from conception.

## Gestational Age

The age of pregnancy measured in weeks from the first day of the last menstrual period (LMP). Also called menstrual age. Typically 2 weeks longer than fertilization age. Calculated using LMP or first-trimester ultrasound. Used to estimate due date (40 weeks from LMP).

### Synonyms:

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menstrual age.

### **Gestational Diabetes**

Glucose intolerance first diagnosed during pregnancy. It may increase the risk of excessive fetal growth, birth complications, neonatal hypoglycemia, and hypertensive pregnancy disorders.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diabetes, Gestational Diabetes During Pregnancy (Gestational Diabetes)

### **Gestational Diabetes Mellitus**

Glucose intolerance first recognized during pregnancy affecting approximately six to nine percent of pregnancies. Results from insulin resistance induced by placental hormones including human placental lactogen, cortisol, and progesterone combined with insufficient beta cell compensation.

### **Gestational Hypertension**

New-onset hypertension after 20 weeks of pregnancy without proteinuria or other features of preeclampsia. It requires monitoring for progression and assessment of maternal and fetal well-being.

### **Gestational Sac**

The first sonographic sign of an intrauterine pregnancy, visible on transvaginal ultrasound at approximately 4.5-5 weeks gestational age. A fluid-filled structure within the decidua, surrounded by the chorionic ring. Mean sac diameter (MSD) correlates with gestational age.

### **Gestational Trophoblastic Disease**

A spectrum of conditions arising from abnormal trophoblast proliferation, including complete and partial hydatidiform moles and gestational choriocarcinoma. Complete mole has 46,XX karyotype (all paternal origin); partial mole is triploid (69 chromosomes). Presents with elevated hCG, uterus large for dates, and vaginal bleeding.

### **Gestational Trophoblastic Neoplasia**

Persistent or malignant trophoblastic disease after a pregnancy event, identified by abnormal or rising beta-hCG, metastases, or histologic criteria. It

includes invasive mole and choriocarcinoma and is highly responsive to risk-adapted chemotherapy.

### **Gettler Test**

Historical quantitative chemical test for drowning, comparing chloride concentration in blood harvested from the left and right heart ventricles.

### **Ghrelin**

A hormone produced mainly in the stomach that influences appetite, energy balance, and growth-hormone release.

### **Giant Cell Arteritis**

A large-vessel vasculitis of adults >50 (peak 70-80) affecting cranial branches of carotid arteries, with risk of permanent vision loss from anterior ischemic optic neuropathy. Clinical: new-onset headache (temporal), scalp tenderness, jaw claudication, visual disturbances (amaurosis fugax, diplopia), polymyalgia rheumatica symptoms.

### **Giant Cell Arteritis Emergency**

Suspected giant cell arteritis with visual symptoms, jaw or tongue claudication, or neurologic ischemia requires immediate glucocorticoid treatment to reduce risk of irreversible visual loss while diagnostic evaluation proceeds.

### **Giant Coronary Aneurysm**

An unusually large dilation of a coronary artery, with risk of thrombosis, rupture, or impaired coronary blood flow.

### **Giant Right Atrium**

Marked dilatation of the right atrium, most commonly caused by chronic severe tricuspid regurgitation, Ebstein anomaly, or long-standing atrial fibrillation with right heart failure. The enlarged atrium may cause compression of adjacent structures, arrhythmias, and thrombus formation. Diagnosis is by echocardiography or cardiac imaging.

### **Giardia Infection**

Intestinal infection caused by the protozoan *Giardia*



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duodenalis, usually acquired from contaminated water, food, or person-to-person spread. It commonly causes foul-smelling diarrhea, bloating, abdominal cramps, and malabsorption.

### **Giardia Lamblia**

A protozoan parasite that causes giardiasis, a diarrhoeal illness transmitted through the fecal-oral route. The organism has a trophozoite and cyst stage. Infection occurs through ingestion of cysts in contaminated water. Symptoms include foul-smelling diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and bloating.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst Eyelid (Giardia Lamblia)

### **Giardiasis**

Infection with *Giardia lamblia* (*G. intestinalis*), a protozoan parasite causing diarrheal illness. Transmission via contaminated water (fecal-oral). Presents with foul-smelling, greasy diarrhea, bloating, abdominal cramps, weight loss, and steatorrhea. Diagnosis: stool antigen testing or microscopy.

### **Giemsa Stain**

A Romanowsky-type stain of methylene blue and eosin dyes used to visualise blood cells and microorganisms in smears and tissue sections. In microbiology it stains *Plasmodium*, *Babesia*, *Trypanosoma*, *Leishmania*, *Borrelia*, and intracellular cytomegalovirus inclusions, supporting rapid diagnosis of blood-borne parasitic and other infections.

### **Gigantism**

Excessive growth hormone (GH) hypersecretion that begins before epiphyseal plate closure in childhood, before the onset of puberty. Results in excessive linear growth and tall stature. Usually caused by a pituitary adenoma. Treatment includes surgery, radiation, and medical therapy.

### **Gilbert Syndrome**

A common, benign autosomal recessive hereditary hyperbilirubinemia caused by a promoter mutation in the *UGT1A1* gene leading to reduced activity (30% of normal) of UDP-glucuronosyltransferase.

### **Gingival Hyperplasia**

An abnormal enlargement or overgrowth of gingival tissue around the teeth that can impair cleaning, cause bleeding, and increase periodontal risk. Causes include plaque-related inflammation and medicines such as phenytoin, cyclosporine, and some calcium-channel blockers; hereditary and systemic conditions can also contribute.

### **Gingival Melanoma**

A rare and aggressive mucosal melanoma arising from melanocytes in the gingival mucosa, presenting as a pigmented or amelanotic nodule or ulcer on the gums. Mucosal melanomas of the head and neck carry a poor prognosis compared to cutaneous melanoma, often presenting at an advanced stage.

### **Gingival Recession**

Apical displacement of the gingival margin from the cemento-enamel junction, exposing the root surface. Causes include periodontal inflammation, traumatic toothbrushing, thin periodontal tissue, tooth position, and iatrogenic factors; it may produce sensitivity and root-carries risk.

### **Gingivectomy**

Surgical removal of gingival tissue. Indications: gingival hyperplasia, cosmetic recontouring, access to caries.

### **Gingivitis**

Inflammation of the gingiva characterized by redness, swelling, and bleeding with brushing or probing, usually due to dental plaque. It is generally reversible with effective oral hygiene and professional cleaning; it can precede periodontitis, but does not inevitably progress to it.

#### **Synonyms:**

Periodontal Disease, Gingivitis

### **Gingivoplasty**

Surgical reshaping of gingiva. Often combined with gingivectomy.



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## Gingivostomatitis

Common viral infection of the mouth and gums, most often caused by primary herpes simplex virus infection but also associated with other infections, trauma, or systemic disease. It may cause painful ulcers, swollen bleeding gums, fever, and difficulty eating or drinking.

## Gitelman Syndrome

Inherited autosomal recessive disorder of the distal convoluted tubule caused by mutations in the NCC sodium-chloride cotransporter gene. Milder than Bartter syndrome typically presenting in adolescence or adulthood.

## Gland

An organized group of epithelial cells specialized for secretion.

## Glandular Fever (Infectious Mononucleosis)

An acute illness usually caused by Epstein-Barr virus, characterized by fever, sore throat, swollen lymph nodes, and fatigue.

### Synonyms:

Infectious Mononucleosis

## Glanzmann Thrombasthenia

An inherited platelet function disorder caused by deficiency or dysfunction of platelet glycoprotein IIb/IIIa, producing mucocutaneous bleeding despite a normal platelet count.

## Glasgow Coma Scale

A standardized assessment of consciousness based on eye opening, verbal response, and motor response, with a total score from 3 to 15. It supports serial neurologic assessment but should be recorded with the individual component scores and confounders.

## Glass Ionomer

Restorative material releasing fluoride. Bonds to tooth structure. Used for pediatric dentistry, cervical lesions, bases.

## Glaucoma

Glaucoma is progressive optic-nerve damage often associated with elevated or dysregulated intraocular pressure, leading to irreversible visual-field loss if untreated. ganglion cells and their axons, resulting in characteristic optic nerve head changes and visual field loss, with elevated intraocular pressure being the most important modifiable risk factor.

## Glaucoma Drainage Implant

A surgically implanted tube-and-plate device that diverts aqueous humor from the anterior chamber to a subconjunctival reservoir, lowering intraocular pressure in selected glaucomas.

## Glenohumeral Joint

Ball-and-socket synovial joint between humeral head and glenoid cavity. Most mobile body joint allowing flexion, extension, abduction, adduction, medial/lateral rotation, circumduction. Mobility trades for stability, making it the most commonly dislocated joint. Stabilized by glenoid labrum, glenohemoral ligaments, and rotator cuff.

## Glenoid Cavity

Shallow pear-shaped depression on the lateral scapular angle articulating with the humeral head. The glenoid labrum deepens the socket by approximately 50 percent. Due to its shallowness, the glenohumeral joint is the most commonly dislocated joint.

## GLIM Criteria

A consensus framework for diagnosing malnutrition using at least one phenotypic criterion, such as weight loss, low body-mass index, or reduced muscle mass, and at least one etiologic criterion, such as reduced intake or assimilation or disease-related inflammation. Severity is graded using phenotypic thresholds.

## Glioblastoma

Grade IV astrocytoma (WHO), the most common and aggressive primary malignant brain tumor in adults. Arises de novo (primary GBM, IDH-wildtype) or from low-grade astrocytoma (secondary, IDH-mutant—better prognosis).

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## Glioma

A tumor arising from glial cells (astrocytes, oligodendrocytes, ependymal cells) in the brain or spinal cord. Includes astrocytomas, oligodendrogliomas, and ependymomas; behavior ranges from low-grade to highly aggressive (glioblastoma).

## Glisson's Capsule

Thin fibrous connective tissue envelope surrounding the liver, sending septa inward dividing it into lobules. Richly innervated by phrenic and intercostal nerve pain fibers, sensitive to distension and inflammation. Covered by visceral peritoneum except at the bare area.

## Global Health

Health issues transcending national boundaries. Examples: pandemics, health disparities, climate change.

## Globin

A family of heme-binding proteins involved in oxygen transport and storage. Structure: globin fold (8 alpha-helices arranged in a globular structure), binds one heme molecule (iron-protoporphyrin IX) per subunit.

## Globulin

A group of serum proteins (globular proteins) that are less soluble in water but soluble in dilute salt solutions. On serum protein electrophoresis, globulins migrate in the alpha-1, alpha-2, beta, and gamma regions. Alpha-1 globulins: alpha-1-antitrypsin, alpha-fetoprotein.

## Globus Sensation

The persistent or intermittent sensation of a lump or foreign body in the throat without an anatomic lesion or dysphagia, also termed globus pharyngeus, typically noticed between meals. There is no impedance to swallowing and no weight loss; the feeling worsens with stress, anxiety, or laryngopharyngeal reflux.

## Glomerular Filtration Rate

Volume of plasma filtered by the glomeruli per

unit time normally ninety to one hundred twenty milliliters per minute per one point seven three square meters body surface area. Estimated by the CKD-EPI equation using serum creatinine, age, sex, and race.

## Glomerulonephritis

Glomerulonephritis is inflammatory injury of the kidney glomeruli, producing hematuria, proteinuria, edema, hypertension, and variable decline in filtration.

nephrotic syndrome) and histopathology (e.g., IgA nephropathy, post-streptococcal, membranoproliferative, crescentic). Presents with hematuria, proteinuria, hypertension, and reduced GFR.

### Synonyms:

GN

## Glomerulopathy

Any disease affecting the renal glomeruli, the capillary structures responsible for blood filtration. It may produce albuminuria or proteinuria, haematuria, reduced filtration, oedema, hypertension, or kidney failure and may be primary or secondary to systemic, metabolic, infectious, or immune disease.

## Glomerulus

The tuft of capillaries in the renal corpuscle (Bowman's capsule) where blood is filtered to form urine.

## Glomus Tumor

A rare benign neoplasm arising from glomus bodies (thermoregulatory shunts), presenting as a small, blue-red, exquisitely tender subungual or digital nodule. The classic triad is severe pain, point tenderness, and cold sensitivity. Diagnosis is clinical with positive Love pin test and Hildreth sign (tumor disappears with ischemia).

## Glomus Tympanicum

A benign vascular tumor arising from the glomus bodies on the promontory of the middle ear, presenting with pulsatile tinnitus, hearing loss, and a reddish mass behind the tympanic membrane.

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## Glossitis

Inflammation of the tongue, which can cause pain, swelling, and changes in tongue appearance. Causes include nutritional deficiencies (iron, B12, folate), infections (bacterial, viral, fungal), allergic reactions, and autoimmune conditions. Treatment depends on the underlying cause.

## Glossopharyngeal Neuralgia

Recurrent, brief attacks of severe stabbing or electric-shock-like pain in the throat, tonsillar region, base of the tongue, or ear, caused by irritation of the glossopharyngeal nerve. Swallowing, coughing, or talking may trigger attacks.

## Glottis

The opening between the vocal folds (true vocal cords) in the larynx, through which air passes during respiration and phonation. Boundaries: anterior (anterior commissure, attachment of vocal folds to thyroid cartilage), posterior (arytenoid cartilages and posterior commissure).

## Gloves

Hand coverings used to protect the wearer, the patient, or both from contamination, chemicals, or injury. Medical gloves may be examination or surgical gloves and may be sterile or nonsterile.

## GLP-1 Receptor Agonist

A glucose-lowering drug that activates the glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor, enhancing glucose-dependent insulin secretion, suppressing inappropriate glucagon secretion, slowing gastric emptying, and increasing satiety.

## Glucagon

A peptide hormone produced by the alpha cells of the pancreatic islets (Langerhans).

## Glucagon Signaling

Glucagon binds GPCR, activates adenylate cyclase, increases cAMP, activates PKA. Promotes glycogenolysis, gluconeogenesis.

## Glucagonoma

A rare pancreatic neuroendocrine tumor that secretes excess glucagon, causing diabetes mellitus (mild, new onset), dermatitis (necrolytic migratory erythema, characteristic painful, erythematous, blistering rash on groin, perineum, extremities), diarrhea, and deep vein thrombosis.

## Glucocorticoid Replacement Therapy

Replacement of cortisol deficiency in adrenal insufficiency using hydrocortisone in divided doses. Typical regimen is ten to fifteen milligrams in the morning and five to ten milligrams in the early afternoon mimicking the physiological cortisol diurnal rhythm.

## Glucocorticoid-Sparing Therapy

Use of a non-glucocorticoid treatment strategy to control inflammation while reducing cumulative corticosteroid exposure. It aims to limit osteoporosis, infection, diabetes, hypertension, adrenal suppression, and other glucocorticoid complications.

## Glucocorticoids

A class of steroid hormones produced by the zona fasciculata of the adrenal cortex, regulated by the hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal (HPA) axis.

## Glucometer

A handheld device that measures blood glucose, usually from a small capillary-blood sample obtained by finger prick.

## Gluconeogenesis

Metabolic pathway generating glucose from non-carbohydrate precursors (lactate, glycerol, glucogenic amino acids). Occurs primarily in liver (90%) and kidney (10%).

## Glucose

A monosaccharide (C<sub>6</sub>H<sub>12</sub>O<sub>6</sub>) that is the primary energy source for cells. Types: D-glucose (dextrose, naturally occurring enantiomer) and L-glucose (synthetic). Routes of entry: dietary carbohydrates (digested to glucose), gluconeogenesis (synthesis from non-carbohydrate precursors), glycogenolysis

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(breakdown of stored glycogen).

### Glucose Intolerance

Impaired handling of glucose resulting in blood-glucose concentrations above normal but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes in a defined testing context. It often reflects insulin resistance or inadequate insulin secretion and is associated with increased risk of type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease.

### Glucose Management Indicator

Derived metric from continuous glucose monitoring that estimates the hemoglobin A1c equivalent based on mean sensor glucose values. Formula converts mean glucose to an A1c-equivalent value allowing comparison between CGM data and traditional A1c.

### Glucose Sensor

Continuous glucose monitor (CGM) for diabetes. Subcutaneous sensor measures interstitial glucose. Transmitter sends data to receiver/phone. Examples: Dexcom, Freestyle Libre, Medtronic. Reduces hypoglycemia, improves A1c.

### Glucose Tolerance Test

Testing for diabetes mellitus and gestational diabetes. 75g OGTT (oral glucose tolerance test): measure plasma glucose at 0, 60, and 120 minutes. Diagnostic: fasting  $\geq 126$  mg/dL, 2-hour  $\geq 200$  mg/dL. Gestational diabetes screening: 50g glucose challenge test (GCT) at 24-28 weeks; if  $>140$  mg/dL at 1 hour, proceed to 100g 3-hour OGTT.

#### Synonyms:

Oral glucose tolerance test (OGTT); gestational diabetes glucose tolerance test.

### Glucose Challenge Test

A screening test for gestational diabetes mellitus, commonly using a nonfasting 50-g glucose drink followed by a one-hour plasma-glucose measurement. An abnormal screening result is followed by a diagnostic oral glucose tolerance test; the threshold depends on the protocol used.

#### Synonyms:

GCT; one-hour glucose challenge test; 50-g glucose

screening test.

### Glucose-6-Phosphatase

Enzyme converting glucose-6-phosphate to glucose. Located in liver and kidney. Deficiency causes Von Gierke disease.

### Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase Deficiency

Glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency is an inherited red-cell enzyme disorder in which oxidative stress can trigger hemolytic anemia after selected infections, foods, or medicines. episodes of hemolytic anemia triggered by oxidative stress from infections, certain drugs including primaquine and sulfonamides, and fava beans. G6PD is essential for generating NADPH to protect red blood cells from oxidative damage.

### Glue (Vascular)

A vascular embolization material used to occlude selected vessels under image guidance.

#### Synonyms:

Vascular

### Glutamate

The principal excitatory neurotransmitter in the central nervous system. Synthesized from glutamine or alpha-ketoglutarate and acting on ionotropic receptors (AMPA, kainate, NMDA) for fast synaptic transmission and metabotropic receptors (mGluR1-8) for modulation.

### Glutathione

Antioxidant tripeptide (Glu-Cys-Gly). Detoxifies reactive metabolites (e.g., NAPQI from acetaminophen). Depletion causes toxicity. N-acetylcysteine replenishes glutathione.

### Gluteal Injury

Damage to the muscles, tendons, nerves, or soft tissues of the buttock caused by trauma, overuse, injection, or falls. Pain, bruising, weakness, or difficulty walking may occur. Severe swelling, numbness, inability to bear weight, or bowel or bladder changes requires urgent evaluation.

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## Gluten

A complex of storage proteins (prolamins and glutelins) found in wheat (gliadin), barley (hordein), and rye (secalin). Gluten provides elasticity to dough. In susceptible individuals, gluten triggers an autoimmune response (celiac disease) or non-autoimmune sensitivity (non-celiac gluten sensitivity, NCGS).

## Gluten-Free Diet

Eliminates gluten (wheat, barley, rye). Essential for celiac disease, non-celiac gluten sensitivity. Risk of nutrient deficiency if not supplemented. May be unnecessarily restrictive for others.

## Gluten-Sensitive Enteropathy (Celiac Disease)

An immune-mediated disorder in which ingestion of gluten damages the lining of the small intestine in genetically susceptible people. It may cause diarrhea, malabsorption, anemia, or other systemic effects.

### Synonyms:

Celiac Disease

## Gluteus Maximus Muscle

Largest, most superficial gluteal muscle forming the buttock bulk, from posterior iliac gluteal line, sacrum, coccyx, and sacrotuberous ligament to the iliotibial tract and gluteal tuberosity. Innervated by inferior gluteal nerve (L5-S2). Primary hip extensor and lateral rotator.

## Gluteus Medius Muscle

Thick fan-shaped muscle between maximus and minimus, from external ilium to the greater trochanter. Innervated by superior gluteal nerve (L4-S1). Primary hip abductor essential for pelvic stability during single-leg stance. Superior gluteal nerve injury causes Trendelenburg sign with contralateral pelvic drop.

## Gluteus Minimus Muscle

The smallest and deepest gluteal muscle, extending from the outer ilium to the greater trochanter. It abducts and medially rotates the hip and helps

stabilize the pelvis during walking.

## Glycaemia

The concentration of glucose in the blood, normally maintained within a narrow range (fasting: 3.9-5.5 mmol/L or 70-100 mg/dL) through the coordinated action of insulin (lowers glucose) and counter-regulatory hormones (glucagon, cortisol, catecholamines, growth hormone).

## Glycemic Control

Management of blood glucose to individualized targets that reduce symptoms and long-term complications while avoiding hypoglycemia. Goals and monitoring methods depend on age, health, treatment, pregnancy, and patient circumstances.

## Glycemic Index

Ranking of carbohydrates by effect on blood glucose. High GI foods spike glucose. Low GI foods provide sustained energy. Useful for diabetes management.

## Glycemic Load

A measure that combines a food's glycemic index with the amount of available carbohydrate in a serving to estimate its effect on blood glucose.

## Glycerin

A colorless, odorless, sweet-tasting trihydroxy alcohol (glycerol) with humectant, osmotic, and solvent properties.

## Glycerol (Glycerine)

A triol compound ( $\text{CH}_2\text{OH}-\text{CHOH}-\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$ ), a colourless, odourless, viscous liquid with a sweet taste.

### Synonyms:

Glycerine

## Glycogen

A branched polysaccharide composed of glucose units linked by alpha-1,4 glycosidic bonds (linear) and alpha-1,6 bonds (branching points, every 8-10 residues). Glycogen serves as the main storage form of glucose in animals.



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## Glycogen Storage Disease

A group of inherited metabolic disorders caused by defects in glycogen synthesis, breakdown, or regulation, resulting in abnormal glycogen accumulation in tissues. Major types: Type I (von Gierke, G6PC deficiency) — fasting hypoglycemia, lactic acidosis, hepatomegaly, hyperuricemia, and hypertriglyceridemia.

## Glycogenesis

The synthesis of glycogen from glucose, primarily in liver and skeletal muscle. Glucose-1-phosphate is converted to UDP-glucose, and glycogen synthase and the branching enzyme extend and branch the polymer; insulin promotes the pathway.

## Glycogenolysis

Breakdown of glycogen to glucose-1-phosphate (converted to glucose-6-phosphate). Liver glycogenolysis maintains blood glucose during fasting; muscle glycogenolysis provides energy for contraction. Regulated by hormonal signals (glucagon, epinephrine) and allosteric effectors (AMP activates phosphorylase).

## Glycolysis

Metabolic pathway breaking down glucose (6C) to pyruvate (3C), generating 2 ATP (net) and 2 NADH. Occurs in cytoplasm. Ten enzymatic steps: investment phase (uses 2 ATP) and payoff phase (produces 4 ATP, 2 NADH). Key regulatory enzymes: hexokinase, phosphofructokinase-1 (PFK-1, rate-limiting), pyruvate kinase.

## Glycosuria

The presence of glucose in the urine. Normally, the renal tubules reabsorb filtered glucose via sodium-glucose co-transporters (SGLT2 in proximal tubule). Glycosuria occurs when blood glucose exceeds the renal threshold (approximately 10 mmol/L or 180 mg/dL), overwhelming reabsorptive capacity.

## GnRH Agonist

Gonadotropin-releasing hormone agonists are a class of medications that initially stimulate (flare effect, 1-3 weeks) and then suppress pituitary gonadotropin

(LH and FSH) secretion through receptor down-regulation, leading to profound suppression of sex steroid production (testosterone in men, estradiol in women).

## GnRH Antagonist

A class of medications that competitively block GnRH receptors on pituitary gonadotrophs, producing immediate, reversible suppression of LH and FSH secretion without the initial flare effect seen with GnRH agonists.

## Goal Attainment Scaling

An individualized outcome method in which patient-specific goals are defined with graded levels of expected attainment and scored after intervention. It captures meaningful changes that standardized measures may miss.

## Goal Setting

SMART goals: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. Patient-centered goals improve adherence.

## Goals-Of-Care Discussion

A clinical conversation that aligns treatment recommendations with a patient's values, priorities, prognosis, acceptable burdens, and preferred outcomes. It may include decisions about hospitalization, resuscitation, artificial nutrition, and comfort-focused care.

## Goiter

Enlargement of the thyroid gland, which can be diffuse or nodular. Causes: iodine deficiency (most common worldwide), Hashimoto thyroiditis, Graves disease, multinodular goiter, and thyroid cancer. May be associated with normal, hyperthyroid, or hypothyroid function.

## Synonyms:

Thyroid Gland Enlargement

## Gold Alloy

Noble metal alloy for dental restorations. Excellent biocompatibility, durability, marginal adaptation. Expensive.



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## Goldenhar Syndrome

A variant of hemifacial microsomia characterized by the triad: epibulbar dermoids (benign conjunctival tumors), preauricular skin tags or sinuses, and vertebral anomalies (hemivertebrae, fused vertebrae, scoliosis). Also involves facial asymmetry, microtia, conductive hearing loss, and macrostomia.

## Goldmann Tonometry

A slit-lamp examination that estimates intraocular pressure by measuring the force needed to flatten a defined area of the cornea.

## Golfer Elbow

Medial epicondylitis, a tendinopathy of the common flexor/pronator tendon at the medial epicondyle. Less common than tennis elbow. Caused by repetitive wrist flexion and forearm pronation. Presents with medial elbow pain worsened by wrist flexion and gripping. Tenderness over the medial epicondyle.

## Golgi Apparatus

Membrane-bound organelle (Golgi complex) consisting of flattened cisternae (cis, medial, trans) that modifies, sorts, and packages proteins and lipids from the ER for secretion or delivery to other organelles.

## Golgi Tendon Organ

A mechanoreceptor located at the junction between a skeletal muscle and its tendon, innervated by Ib afferent fibers. The Golgi tendon organ detects tension generated by muscle contraction or passive stretch.

## Gonadal Dysgenesis

Incomplete or abnormal development of the ovaries or testes, often resulting from chromosomal abnormalities, gene variants, or disordered sex development. It may cause atypical genital development, delayed or absent puberty, infertility, and abnormal gonadal hormone production.

## Gonadotrophins

Hormones that stimulate the gonads. The ante-

rior pituitary secretes follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) and luteinising hormone (LH), both glycoprotein hormones sharing a common alpha subunit (identical to TSH and hCG alpha) with a unique beta subunit.

## Gonads

The primary reproductive organs: testes in males and ovaries in females. Functions: (1) gamete production (spermatogenesis in testes, oogenesis in ovaries); (2) sex steroid hormone secretion (testosterone from testicular Leydig cells; estrogen and progesterone from ovarian follicular cells and corpus luteum).

## Gonioscopy

An ophthalmological examination technique that allows direct visualization of the anterior chamber angle, the anatomical region where the cornea and iris meet and where the trabecular meshwork is located, and it is essential for distinguishing between open-angle and angle-closure forms of glaucoma.

## Gonococcal Arthritis

A disseminated infection of joints caused by *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, often with fever, migratory joint or tendon pain, skin pustules, and tenosynovitis. It requires prompt antimicrobial treatment and evaluation for concomitant sexually transmitted infection.

## Gonococcal Pharyngitis

Infection of the throat by *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, usually acquired through sexual contact. It may cause sore throat or no symptoms.

## Gonorrhea

Gonorrhea is a sexually transmitted infection caused by *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, producing urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, rectal or pharyngeal infection, and neonatal disease. gonorrhoeae. Epidemiology: second most common bacterial STI (after Chlamydia), highest incidence in 15-24 year olds.

## Goodpasture Syndrome

Anti-GBM disease affecting both kidneys and lungs.

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Pulmonary hemorrhage with hemoptysis and crescentic GN. Linear IgG deposits on renal biopsy. Emergent plasmapheresis, cyclophosphamide, and steroids. Early treatment essential to prevent irreversible renal and pulmonary damage.

### **Gottron Papules**

A characteristic skin finding of dermatomyositis, consisting of erythematous to violaceous lichenoid papules located over the dorsal aspects of the interphalangeal (PIP/DIP) and metacarpophalangeal (MCP) joints. May undergo necrosis or ulceration.

### **Gout**

Gout is inflammatory arthritis caused by monosodium urate crystal deposition, classically causing abrupt severe pain and swelling in a joint and potentially forming tophi or kidney stones. episodes of acute inflammatory arthritis and may cause chronic tophi or kidney stones.

### **Gout Flare**

An acute inflammatory response to monosodium urate crystal deposition in or around a joint. It commonly causes abrupt severe pain, swelling, warmth, and erythema, often involving the first metatarsophalangeal joint; aspiration can confirm crystals and exclude infection.

### **Gout Nodulosis**

The formation of tophi—large, firm, subcutaneous nodules composed of monosodium urate crystals—resulting from chronic, poorly controlled hyperuricemia. Tophi most commonly occur at the ears, fingers, toes, olecranon bursae, and Achilles tendon, and may ulcerate and discharge chalky white material.

### **Gown**

Protective clothing. Types: examination, surgical, isolation.

### **Grade**

Degree of cellular differentiation. Grade 1: well-differentiated. Grade 2: moderately differentiated. Grade 3: poorly differentiated. Grade 4: undiffer-

entiated.

### **Graded Potentials**

Local changes in membrane potential that vary in magnitude proportional to stimulus strength, unlike all-or-none action potentials. They include receptor potentials (in sensory receptors), postsynaptic potentials (EPSPs and IPSPs at synapses), and pacemaker potentials (in cardiac/specialized cells).

### **Graft**

Tissue or a synthetic material transferred to another site to replace, repair, reinforce, or bypass a damaged body structure.

### **Graft (Periodontal)**

Tissue used to cover exposed root or augment gingiva. Connective tissue graft (gold standard), free gingival graft, allograft, xenograft.

#### **Synonyms:**

Periodontal

### **Graft-Versus-Host Disease**

An immune-mediated complication of allogeneic hematopoietic transplantation in which donor-derived immunocompetent T cells attack recipient tissues. Acute or chronic GVHD commonly affects skin, liver, and gastrointestinal tract and requires prevention and immunosuppressive treatment.

### **Grafting**

The surgical transfer of tissue or a synthetic substitute to repair, replace, or support a body structure. An autograft comes from the same person, whereas an allograft comes from another person of the same species.

### **Gram Negative Bacilli**

Rod-shaped gram-negative bacteria appearing pink on Gram stain owing to a thin peptidoglycan layer and lipopolysaccharide outer membrane.

### **Gram Positive Cocci**

Spherical gram-positive bacteria staining purple owing to a thick peptidoglycan layer and absent outer

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membrane. Clinically important genera include *Staphylococcus*, *Streptococcus*, and *Enterococcus*, identifiable by arrangement (clusters, chains, pairs) and hemolysis, and causing skin, pharyngeal, respiratory, and bloodstream infections.

### Gram Stain

A clinical condition or finding involving gram stain. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context. on cell wall structure. The procedure involves crystal violet staining, iodine mordant, alcohol decolorisation, and safranin counterstain.

### Gram-Negative Bacteria

Bacteria that do not retain crystal violet during Gram staining and therefore appear pink or red. They have a thin peptidoglycan layer and an outer membrane that may contain lipopolysaccharide. Examples include *Escherichia coli*, *Klebsiella*, *Pseudomonas*, and *Neisseria*.

### Gram-Negative Meningitis

Meningitis caused by gram-negative bacteria, including *Escherichia coli*, *Klebsiella*, and *Neisseria* species. It can progress rapidly to sepsis, neurologic injury, and death and requires urgent cerebrospinal-fluid evaluation and antimicrobial treatment.

### Gram-Positive Bacteria

Bacteria that retain crystal violet in the Gram stain (appear purple/blue), characterized by a thick peptidoglycan cell wall and no outer membrane.

### Grand Mal

A type of generalised seizure characterized by bilateral synchronous epileptic activity involving the entire brain. Formerly called grand mal, now classified as bilateral tonic-clonic seizure according to the ILAE 2017 classification.

### Granular Casts

Degenerated cellular debris within tubular lumen appearing as coarse or fine-grained structures. Coarse casts represent more acute process, fine casts indicate chronic degenerative process. Common in

acute tubular necrosis reflecting tubular epithelial cell damage. Also seen in chronic kidney disease, nephrotic syndrome, and hypertension.

### Granulocyte

A granulocyte is a white blood cell containing cytoplasmic granules; neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils are granulocytes involved in innate immunity, inflammation, and host defense. on light microscopy. Granulocytes are produced in the bone marrow (myelopoiesis, 3-4 days maturation) and are part of the innate immune system.

### Granuloma

A distinctive pattern of chronic inflammation characterized by the aggregation of modified macrophages (epithelioid histiocytes), often with multinucleated giant cells (Langhans or foreign-body type), surrounded by lymphocytes. Granulomas form when macrophages cannot eliminate a persistent antigen or pathogen.

### Granuloma Annulare

A benign inflammatory condition characterized by annular, erythematous to skin-colored plaques with raised borders and central clearing. It most commonly affects the hands, feet, and elbows. Localized form is most common; generalized form is associated with diabetes mellitus.

### Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis

GPA (formerly Wegener granulomatosis): an ANCA-associated small-vessel necrotizing vasculitis affecting the upper and lower respiratory tract and kidneys.

#### Synonyms:

Wegeners Granulomatosis (Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis)

### Granulomatous Amebic Encephalitis

A rare, usually fatal central nervous system infection caused by free-living amoebae such as *Acanthamoeba* species, typically affecting immunocompromised individuals. It presents with a subacute to chronic meningoencephalitis and forms granulomatous lesions in the brain.

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## Granulomatous Inflammation

A distinctive pattern of chronic inflammation characterized by organized collections of activated macrophages that have undergone morphological transformation into epithelioid cells, often surrounded by a rim of lymphocytes and occasionally fibroblasts.

## Granulosa Cell Tumor

An estrogen-secreting ovarian sex cord-stromal tumor that can cause precocious puberty, endometrial hyperplasia, or carcinoma. Generally low-grade with a tendency to late recurrence.

## Graves Disease

Autoimmune disorder and most common cause of hyperthyroidism characterized by thyroid-stimulating immunoglobulins that bind and activate the thyroid-stimulating hormone receptor causing unregulated thyroid hormone synthesis and secretion. The diffuse goiter reflects TSH receptor stimulation.

## Gray (Gy)

The SI unit of absorbed radiation dose, equal to one joule of ionizing radiation energy deposited per kilogram of matter. It describes physical energy absorption and differs from the sievert, which incorporates biologic weighting.

### Synonyms:

Gy

## Gray Matter

Regions of the brain and spinal cord composed primarily of nerve cell bodies, dendrites, and synapses, responsible for processing information.

## Greater Curvature

Convex lateral stomach border from gastroesophageal junction to pylorus, approximately four times longer than the lesser curvature. Attachment site for the greater omentum. Blood supply from short gastric and left gastroepiploic vessels. Common site for gastric ulcers and cancer.

## Greater Trochanter

Large quadrilateral lateral proximal femoral prominence. Insertion for gluteus medius/minimus and piriformis. Palpable landmark and site of trochanteric bursa. Intertrochanteric fractures between trochanters are extracapsular with lower avascular necrosis risk because periosteal blood supply is preserved.

## Grey Turner's Sign

Bluish or violaceous ecchymosis of the flanks caused by retroperitoneal bleeding tracking through the abdominal wall. It is classically associated with severe haemorrhagic pancreatitis but may occur with other retroperitoneal haemorrhage.

## Grid Implant

A flexible electrode array placed on or near the brain or another tissue surface to record electrical activity or deliver stimulation.

## Grief

The natural emotional response to loss, particularly the death of a loved one, but also following other significant losses such as divorce, job loss, or declining health. It encompasses a range of feelings including sadness, anger, guilt, and numbness, often occurring in waves rather than linear stages.

## Gripping

Cramping or spasmodic abdominal pain, often caused by contractions or obstruction of a hollow organ.

## Grippe

An older name for influenza, a viral respiratory illness that commonly causes fever, cough, body aches, and fatigue.

## Griscelli Syndrome

Three types: Type 1 (MYO5A mutation): primary neurologic impairment, no immunodeficiency; Type 2 (RAB27A mutation): immunodeficiency + partial albinism, HLH risk; Type 3 (MLPH mutation): only partial albinism. Type 2: silvery hair, large melanosomes in melanocytes, defective cytotoxic

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granule release -> HLH.

### Gross Examination

The macroscopic, naked-eye inspection of a specimen in the pathology laboratory, performed before microscopic sectioning and the essential first step in pathologic diagnosis of resected tissues and organs.

### Gross Motor Skills

The ability to use large muscle groups for movement and posture, developing in a predictable sequence in infancy/childhood: head control (3 months), sitting (6 months), crawling (9 months), standing (10-12 months), walking (12-18 months), running/jumping (2-3 years), hopping and balance (3-5 years).

### Ground-Glass Opacity

Hazy lung opacity on CT without obscuring vessels. Non-specific, may represent inflammation, edema, fibrosis, malignancy.

### Group A Strep

Group A Streptococcus (*Streptococcus pyogenes*), a gram-positive coccus in chains, beta-hemolytic. Infections: pharyngitis/tonsillitis, impetigo, erysipelas, cellulitis, scarlet fever, necrotizing fasciitis, streptococcal toxic shock syndrome, pneumonia, and puerperal sepsis.

### Group A Streptococcus

*Streptococcus pyogenes*, a bacterium that can cause pharyngitis, skin infections, invasive disease, and immune-mediated complications.

### Group B Strep

Group B Streptococcus (GBS, *Streptococcus agalactiae*): a gram-positive coccus colonizing the GI and genitourinary tract in 10-30 percent of women; major cause of neonatal sepsis and meningitis.

### Group B Streptococcus

A gram-positive bacterium (*Streptococcus agalactiae*) colonizing the genitourinary and gastrointestinal tracts. Asymptomatic vaginal colonization occurs in 20-30% of pregnant women. Screening is

performed at 36-37 weeks gestation via rectovaginal swab culture.

### Growing Pains

Recurrent, bilateral leg pain in children ages 3-12, typically occurring in the late afternoon or evening and resolving by morning. Pain is deep, aching in the calves, shins, and thighs (not joints). No limping, fever, swelling, or functional impairment.

### Growth Chart

A graphical representation of growth (weight, height/length, head circumference, BMI) plotted against age, standardized by population (WHO growth standards 0-5 years; CDC growth charts 2-20 years; percentiles/z-scores).

### Growth Factor

Proteins that stimulate cell growth, proliferation, differentiation, and survival. Major families: EGF (epidermal growth factor), FGF (fibroblast growth factor), PDGF (platelet-derived), VEGF (vascular endothelial), TGF-beta (transforming), NGF (nerve), IGF (insulin-like), HGF (hepatocyte).

### Growth Hormone

A hormone released by the anterior pituitary that promotes growth partly through insulin-like growth factor 1 and also affects protein, fat, and carbohydrate metabolism.

### Growth Hormone Deficiency

Insufficient secretion of growth hormone from the anterior pituitary, causing short stature in children and metabolic effects in adults. In children: delayed growth, short stature, delayed bone age, and increased fat mass. In adults: decreased muscle mass, increased fat mass, reduced bone density, fatigue, and dyslipidemia.

### Growth Hormone Physiology

Growth hormone is secreted in a pulsatile pattern by pituitary somatotroph cells regulated by hypothalamic GHRH which stimulates release and somatostatin which inhibits release. GH acts directly on tissues and indirectly through IGF-1 produced pri-



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marily by the liver.

### **Growth Medium**

A nutrient preparation supporting microbial multiplication in vitro, supplying carbon, nitrogen, minerals, and growth factors in liquid or solid form.

### **Growth Retardation**

Abnormally slow physical growth or failure to reach expected height or weight for age and developmental stage. Causes include inadequate nutrition, chronic systemic disease, endocrine or genetic disorders, malabsorption, psychosocial deprivation, and constitutional variation; assessment uses growth charts and clinical context.

### **Growth Scan**

An ultrasound examination used to assess fetal size, growth pattern, amniotic fluid, and sometimes blood flow. Measurements are compared with gestational-age standards to identify possible growth restriction or excessive growth.

### **Guaifenesin**

An expectorant used to loosen respiratory mucus and make coughing more productive. It provides symptomatic relief in some respiratory illnesses; dosing depends on the formulation and patient.

### **Guided Tissue Regeneration**

Periodontal procedure using barrier membrane to promote regeneration of bone, cementum, periodontal ligament.

### **Guillain-Barre Syndrome**

An acute, immune-mediated polyneuropathy typically presenting with ascending paralysis following an antecedent infection (*Campylobacter jejuni*, CMV, EBV, Zika). Variants: acute inflammatory demyelinating polyneuropathy (AIDP, most common in North America), acute motor axonal neuropathy (AMAN, more common in Asia).

### **Gummy Smile**

Excessive gingival display when smiling. Caused

by hypermobile lip, vertical maxillary excess, altered passive eruption. Treatment: surgery, Botox, orthodontics.

### **Gunshot Wound**

An injury produced by a projectile discharged from a firearm; forensic classification by range and direction. Entrance wound: rounded/ovoid defect with an abraded ring and often a zone of soot (close range) or stippling/tattooing (intermediate range); contact wounds show muzzle imprint.

### **Gut Microbiome**

The complex community of trillions of microorganisms, including bacteria, viruses, and fungi, residing in the gastrointestinal tract. The gut microbiome plays a crucial role in digestion, immune function, vitamin synthesis, and protection against pathogens.

### **Guttate Psoriasis**

An acute eruption of numerous small, scaly, drop-like psoriatic papules and plaques, often following streptococcal pharyngitis in children or young adults. Diagnosis is clinical; the eruption may resolve spontaneously or evolve into chronic plaque psoriasis.

### **Gynaecologist**

A medical doctor who specializes in the health of the female reproductive system (vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries) and breasts.

### **Gynaecomastia**

The benign enlargement of breast tissue in males. Pathophysiology: an imbalance between estrogen (stimulates breast tissue growth) and androgen (suppresses) activity, resulting in increased estrogen-to-testosterone ratio.

### **Gynecology**

The medical specialty concerned with the health of the female reproductive system (uterus, ovaries, fallopian tubes, cervix, vagina, and vulva).



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## Gynecomastia

Enlargement of breast tissue in males, often bilateral, occurring physiologically in neonates, during puberty (40-60% of boys), and in aging men. Pathologic causes include Klinefelter syndrome, testicular tumors, medications (spironolactone, cannabis), and liver disease. Persistent or asymmetric gynecomastia warrants evaluation.

### Synonyms:

Man Boobs (Gynecomastia)

## Gyrus

A ridge or convolution on the surface of the cerebral cortex, separated by sulci (grooves). The folded structure triples the surface area of the brain (approximately 2500 cm<sup>2</sup>) while fitting within the cranial vault.

## Gallbladder Carcinoma

A malignant tumour arising from the gallbladder, most often an adenocarcinoma. It may be discovered incidentally after cholecystectomy or present with right-upper-quadrant pain, jaundice, weight loss, or biliary obstruction; staging determines surgical and systemic treatment.

## Gallbladder Infection

Inflammation or infection of the gallbladder, often associated with blockage of bile flow.

## Giant Cell Tumor

A usually benign but locally aggressive bone tumor containing numerous giant cells.

## Glomerulosclerosis

Scarring of the glomeruli, the kidney structures that filter blood.

## Gonadoblastoma

A rare tumor of an abnormal or developmentally disordered gonad that may contain germ cells and sex-cord cells.

## Gonococcal Urethritis

Inflammation of the urethra caused by infection

with *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*.

## Granuloma Inguinale

A chronic sexually transmitted infection that causes ulcerative lesions of the genital region.

## Granulomatosis

A disorder characterized by formation of granulomas, which are organized collections of immune cells caused by chronic inflammation.

## Growth Failure

Abnormally slow physical growth or inadequate weight gain compared with expected development.

## Gyrate Atrophy

An inherited retinal disorder causing progressive loss of peripheral vision and night vision.

## Gastrointestinal Tract

The continuous digestive passage from the mouth through the esophagus, stomach, intestines, rectum, and anus.

## Ganglioglioma

A usually slow-growing brain or spinal-cord tumor made of nerve cells and supporting glial cells.

## Gas And Gas Pains

Gas-related fullness, bloating, or abdominal discomfort caused by swallowed or intestinal gas.

## Golfer's Elbow

Painful inflammation or degeneration of tendons on the inner side of the elbow.

## Group B Streptococcal Disease

Infection caused by group B *Streptococcus* bacteria, which can be serious in newborns and vulnerable adults.

## Gamma Globulin

The fraction of blood plasma containing most immunoglobulins, or antibodies.

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### **Gas Transport**

Movement of oxygen from the lungs to tissues and carbon dioxide from tissues to the lungs through the blood.

### **Gastroduodenostomy**

Surgical creation of an opening between the stomach and duodenum.

### **Gastrojejunostomy**

Surgical creation of an opening between the stomach and jejunum.

### **Genu Varum**

Outward bowing of the legs, commonly called bowlegs.

**Synonyms:**  
bowlegs.

### **Glomerular Capsule**

The cup-shaped structure surrounding a kidney glomerulus that receives filtered fluid.

### **Glomerular Filtrate**

Fluid filtered from blood into the kidney tubules at the glomerulus.

### **Glucosamine**

A naturally occurring compound used in cartilage formation and sometimes taken as a supplement for joint symptoms.

### **Goniometer**

An instrument used to measure the angle or range of motion of a joint.

### **Graafian Follicle**

A mature ovarian follicle that contains an egg ready for ovulation.

### **Graft-Versus-Host Reaction**

An immune reaction in which transplanted donor immune cells attack the recipient's tissues.

### **Greater Omentum**

A fold of fatty peritoneal tissue that hangs from the stomach and partly covers the abdominal organs.

### **Gustation**

The sense of taste.

### **Gowers Sign**

A maneuver in which a person uses the hands to push up from the floor or thighs because of proximal muscle weakness, classically seen in muscular dystrophy.

### **Ganglion Cyst**

A benign, fluid-filled cyst arising near a joint or tendon sheath, most often at the wrist or hand. It may be painless or cause pressure, discomfort, or limitation of movement.

**Synonyms:**  
Cyst, Ganglion

### **Gastric Varices**

Enlarged veins in the stomach wall caused by portal hypertension, usually related to liver disease or obstruction of the splenic or portal venous circulation. Rupture can cause life-threatening gastrointestinal bleeding.

### **Gag Reflex (Pharyngeal Reflex)**

A protective reflex in which stimulation of the back of the throat produces contraction of the pharyngeal muscles and may trigger retching. It helps protect the airway from foreign material.

**Synonyms:**  
Pharyngeal Reflex

### **GAG (Glycosaminoglycan)**

A long, unbranched carbohydrate chain found in the extracellular matrix and connective tissues. Abnormal breakdown or accumulation of GAGs occurs in mucopolysaccharidoses.

**Synonyms:**  
Glycosaminoglycan

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## Gamete

A mature reproductive cell, such as a sperm or ovum, containing one set of chromosomes and combining with another gamete at fertilization.

## Gastroenterostomy

Surgical creation of an opening between the stomach and a segment of the small intestine, usually the jejunum, to bypass or replace a blocked or diseased gastric outlet.

## Genetics

Genetics is the study of genes, heredity, genetic variation, and how DNA and gene regulation influence traits, disease risk, diagnosis, and treatment response.

## Genome

The complete genetic material of an organism, including its genes and noncoding DNA.

## Genu Valgum (Knock-Knee)

An alignment abnormality in which the knees angle inward and may touch while the ankles remain apart. It may be developmental or caused by bone, joint, or metabolic disease.

### Synonyms:

Knock-Knee

## Glans Penis

The expanded, sensitive distal end of the penis containing the external urethral opening and covered by the foreskin when present.

## Global Aphasia

A severe language disorder caused by extensive damage to the dominant cerebral hemisphere, impairing speech production, comprehension, reading, and writing.

## Glue Ear (Secretory Otitis Media)

Persistent fluid in the middle ear without acute infection, often causing conductive hearing loss and a feeling of blockage. It is common in children.

### Synonyms:

Secretory Otitis Media

## Groin

The region where the lower abdomen meets the upper thigh, containing the inguinal canal and related muscles, vessels, nerves, and lymph nodes.

## Gestational Pyelonephritis

A kidney infection occurring during pregnancy, usually causing fever, flank pain, nausea, or urinary symptoms. It can lead to sepsis, preterm labor, or respiratory complications and requires prompt clinical assessment.

### Synonyms:

Pyelonephritis in pregnancy; pregnancy-associated kidney infection.

## Gaba Receptor

A receptor activated by gamma-aminobutyric acid that usually inhibits neuronal firing; GABA-A receptors are ligand-gated chloride channels and GABA-B receptors are metabotropic.

## Gabapentin

An anticonvulsant also used for neuropathic pain and selected other pain syndromes; dizziness, sedation, and dose adjustment in kidney disease are important considerations.

## Gadoleic Acid

A 20-carbon monounsaturated fatty acid found in some plant and marine oils and incorporated into dietary and cellular lipids.

## Gadolinium

Gadolinium is a lanthanide metal used in chelated form as a contrast agent for MRI; severe reactions are uncommon, but tissue retention and nephrogenic systemic fibrosis matter in advanced kidney disease.

## Gadopentetate Dimeglumine

Gadopentetate dimeglumine is a gadolinium-based extracellular MRI contrast agent that shortens T1 relaxation and increases lesion conspicuity; renal function and prior contrast reactions should be con-

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sidered.

### **Gaffkya Homari**

gaffkya homari is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Gag Gene**

The retroviral gene encoding structural proteins that form the viral core, matrix, and capsid and help assemble new virus particles.

### **Gag Protein**

A retroviral structural polyprotein processed into matrix, capsid, nucleocapsid, and related components required for virion assembly.

### **Gait Apraxia**

Difficulty initiating or correctly executing walking despite adequate strength, often associated with frontal-lobe, vascular, degenerative, or hydrocephalus-related disease.

### **Gait Ataxia**

An unsteady, poorly coordinated gait caused by dysfunction of the cerebellum, sensory pathways, vestibular system, or other neurologic structures.

### **Galactans**

galactans is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Galactolipids**

Lipids containing galactose, important in plant membranes and nervous-system myelin and involved in membrane structure and recognition.

### **Galactose**

A simple sugar, commonly present in lactose, that is metabolized through the Leloir pathway; inherited galactosemia can make exposure dangerous in infancy.

### **Galactosialidosis**

A rare lysosomal-storage disorder caused by deficiency of protective protein/cathepsin A, leading to accumulation of oligosaccharides and variable neurologic, skeletal, renal, and eye findings.

### **Galactoside**

galactoside is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Galactosyltransferase**

galactosyltransferase is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Galanin**

A neuropeptide distributed in the brain and peripheral nervous system that influences pain, appetite, mood, hormone release, and gastrointestinal function.

### **Galiximab**

A medicine or chemical compound called galiximab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Gall Bladder Disease**

A disorder of the gallbladder, including stones, inflammation, infection, polyps, dyskinesia, or cancer, often causing right-upper-abdominal pain or nausea.

### **Gallamine Triethiodide**

Gallamine triethiodide is a non-depolarising neuromuscular blocker that competitively antagonizes nicotinic acetylcholine receptors at the neuromuscular junction, causing skeletal-muscle paralysis during anaesthesia.

### **Gallbladder Necrosis**

Death of gallbladder tissue, usually from severe inflammation or loss of blood supply, and a potential precursor to perforation and sepsis requiring urgent

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care.

### **Gallbladder Perforation**

A hole in the gallbladder wall that can release bile or infected contents into the abdomen, causing peritonitis, abscess, or sepsis.

### **Gallic Acid**

A plant-derived phenolic acid found in tea, fruit, and other foods and studied for antioxidant, antimicrobial, and experimental anticancer effects.

### **Gallium**

Gallium is a metallic element used in some radio-tracers and medical imaging and in semiconductor technology; its clinical interpretation depends on the isotope, compound, and distribution.

### **Gallium Nitrate**

A clinical condition or finding involving gallium nitrate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gametogenesis**

Formation and maturation of sperm or eggs through meiosis and cellular differentiation in the testes or ovaries.

### **Gamma Rays**

gamma rays is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gamma Synuclein**

A clinical condition or finding involving gamma synuclein. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gamma-Chemokines**

A clinical condition or finding involving gamma-chemokines. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gammacoronavirus**

gammacoronavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Gammaherpesvirina**

gammaherpesvirina is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Gammaretrovirus**

gammaretrovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Ganciclovir**

Ganciclovir is a guanosine analogue antiviral that inhibits viral DNA polymerase after phosphorylation and is used mainly against cytomegalovirus; neutropenia, thrombocytopenia, renal toxicity, and teratogenicity are important risks.

### **Ganglia**

ganglia is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Ganglion Cell**

A neuron whose cell body lies in a peripheral or retinal ganglion; retinal ganglion cells transmit visual signals through the optic nerve.

### **Ganglioneuroma**

ganglioneuroma is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

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### **Ganglioneuromatosis**

ganglioneuromatosis is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Ganglioside**

ganglioside is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Gangliosidosis**

gangliosidosis is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Gap Junction**

gap junction is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Gardner Syndrome**

An inherited APC-related polyposis syndrome with numerous colorectal adenomas and extraintestinal findings such as osteomas, dental abnormalities, and desmoid tumors.

### **Gardnerella**

gardnerella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Gardnerella Vaginalis**

gardnerella vaginalis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Garlic**

garlic is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gartner Duct**

A persistent remnant of the mesonephric duct in the female genital tract that can form a vaginal or broad-ligament cyst.

### **Gas**

gas is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Strep Throat (GAS)

### **Gas Chromatography**

gas chromatography is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gas Poisoning**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving gas poisoning; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Gas Scavenger**

gas scavenger is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gastric Balloon**

A temporary endoscopically placed balloon that occupies space in the stomach to support weight loss; complications include nausea, vomiting, obstruction, and perforation.

### **Gastric Dysplasia**

Abnormal precancerous-appearing growth of gastric lining cells, graded by pathology and associated with increased risk of gastric adenocarcinoma.

### **Gastric Fistula**

An abnormal connection involving the stomach and another organ or the skin, which may cause leakage, infection, malnutrition, or drainage.



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### **Gastric Fundus**

gastric fundus is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Gastric Hemorrhage**

Bleeding from the stomach caused by ulcer, erosive gastritis, varices, tumor, vascular lesion, or other injury, potentially producing hematemesis or melena.

### **Gastric Juice**

The acidic digestive secretion of the stomach containing hydrochloric acid, pepsinogen, mucus, intrinsic factor, water, and electrolytes.

### **Gastric Leiomyosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting gastric leiomyosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Gastric Mucosa**

gastric mucosa is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Gastric Necrosis**

Death of stomach tissue from ischemia, caustic injury, severe distension, infection, or other insult, with risk of perforation and systemic illness.

### **Gastric Obstruction**

Impaired passage of stomach contents caused by narrowing or blockage at the stomach or gastric outlet, producing vomiting, pain, distension, and dehydration.

### **Gastric Stenosis**

Abnormal narrowing of the stomach or gastric outlet, from congenital disease, ulcer scarring, inflammation, tumor, or hypertrophy, that impedes emptying.

### **Gastroenteritis Bacterial**

gastroenteritis bacterial is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Gastroenterologist**

A physician specializing in disorders of the digestive tract, liver, gallbladder, and pancreas.

### **Gastroepiploic Artery**

gastroepiploic artery is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Gastrointestinal Agents**

gastrointestinal agents is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal Disorder**

gastrointestinal disorder is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal Gas**

gastrointestinal gas is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal Hemorrhage**

gastrointestinal hemorrhage is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal Hormone**

gastrointestinal hormone is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal Neoplasm**

gastrointestinal neoplasm is a diagnostic or labora-

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tory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastrointestinal System**

gastrointestinal system is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Gastroscope**

gastroscope is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Gastroscopy**

Endoscopic examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum, allowing direct visualization, biopsy, and selected treatments.

### **Gastrula**

An early embryo stage formed after gastrulation, when cell layers reorganize into ectoderm, mesoderm, and endoderm that give rise to body tissues.

### **Gatifloxacin**

Gatifloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; systemic use is restricted in many settings because of dysglycaemia and other class toxicities, while ophthalmic use remains available in some regions.

### **Gauss**

A unit of magnetic flux density equal to  $10^{-4}$  tesla, used in physics, imaging, and descriptions of magnetic fields.

### **Gefitinib**

A clinical condition or finding involving gefitinib. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gel Electrophoresis**

gel electrophoresis is a chemical, laboratory, genetic,

or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gelatin**

gelatin is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Geldanamycin Analogue**

A medicine or chemical compound called geldanamycin analogue. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Gelsolin**

gelsolin is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gemcitabine**

Gemcitabine is a pyrimidine antimetabolite that inhibits DNA synthesis after intracellular activation and is used for several solid tumors; myelosuppression, flu-like symptoms, rash, and pulmonary or hepatic toxicity may occur.

### **Gemcitabine Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving gemcitabine hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gemella**

gemella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Gemella Bergeri**

gemella bergeri is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

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### **Gemella Haemolysans**

gemella haemolysans is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Gemella Morbillorum**

gemella morbillorum is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Gemella Sanguinis**

gemella sanguinis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Gemifloxacin**

A medicine or chemical compound called gemifloxacin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Gemtuzumab Ozogamicin**

A medicine or chemical compound called gemtuzumab ozogamicin. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Gender**

A social and personal construct involving roles, identity, expression, and expectations associated with sex; it is distinct from biological sex and sexual orientation.

### **Gender Identity**

A person's internal sense of being a woman, man, both, neither, or another gender, which may or may not correspond to sex assigned at birth.

### **Gene Amplification**

An increase in the number of copies of a gene or genomic region, which can raise gene expression and drive some inherited conditions or cancers.

### **Gene Conversion**

A nonreciprocal transfer of sequence information from one DNA region to a homologous region, potentially changing an allele during recombination or repair.

### **Gene Deletion**

Loss of part or all of a gene from DNA, potentially abolishing its product or altering dosage and causing disease when clinically significant.

### **Gene Dosage**

The number of functional copies of a gene and the amount of product they produce, influenced by deletions, duplications, chromosome number, and regulation.

### **Gene Duplication**

An extra copy of a gene created by replication or rearrangement, which may have no effect, alter dosage, or provide material for new gene function.

### **Gene Frequency**

The proportion of a particular allele among all copies of a gene in a population.

### **Gene Fusion**

A hybrid gene formed when segments of two separate genes join, sometimes producing an abnormal protein that drives cancer or other disease.

### **Gene Library**

A collection of cloned DNA fragments representing genomic DNA, complementary DNA, or selected sequences for laboratory screening and analysis.

### **Gene Modification**

An intentional or naturally occurring alteration of DNA sequence or gene regulation that changes cellular function or inherited traits.

### **Gene Mutation**

A permanent change in the DNA sequence of a gene, which may be harmless, beneficial, or pathogenic depending on its effect and inheritance.

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## Gene Rearrangement

Reorganization of DNA segments within or between chromosomes that can alter gene structure, expression, immune-receptor diversity, or cancer biology.

## Gene Silencing

Suppression of gene expression through DNA methylation, chromatin changes, RNA interference, or other mechanisms.

## Gene Targeting

A molecular method that changes a chosen genomic locus through homologous recombination or engineered editing to study or alter gene function.

## Gene Transfer

Movement of genetic material into a cell or organism, naturally or through laboratory vectors, potentially changing gene expression or correcting a defect.

## Gene-Environment Interaction

A gene-environment interaction occurs when an environmental exposure changes disease risk differently according to a person's genotype, so inherited susceptibility and exposure jointly influence phenotype.

## Gene-Modified

Describing cells or organisms whose genetic material has been deliberately altered using recombinant DNA or genome-editing methods.

## Generalized

Distributed widely or involving most or all of a body region, system, or population rather than being confined to one focus.

## Generalized Lipodystrophy

A disorder with near-total loss of adipose tissue, severe insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, fatty liver, and abnormal fat deposition in other tissues.

## Generalized Seizure

A seizure arising from or rapidly involving both cerebral hemispheres, commonly producing impaired

awareness, bilateral motor activity, or brief absence episodes.

## Genetic Anticipation

Earlier onset or increasing severity of a hereditary disorder in successive generations, often caused by expansion of unstable repeated DNA sequences.

## Genetic Carrier

A person with one pathogenic variant for a recessive disorder who is usually unaffected but can transmit the variant to children.

## Genetic Disorder

A disease caused wholly or partly by a pathogenic change in DNA, chromosome structure or number, or gene regulation.

## Genetic Drift

Random changes in allele frequencies from one generation to the next, especially in small populations, independent of natural selection.

## Genetic Engineering

Deliberate alteration, insertion, deletion, or transfer of genetic material using molecular biology techniques.

## Genetic Linkage

The tendency of nearby genes or DNA markers on the same chromosome to be inherited together because crossing over is less likely between them.

## Genetic Marker

A detectable DNA variation or feature used to track inheritance, identify a chromosome region, assess disease risk, or distinguish samples.

## Genetic Polymorphism

A common DNA variation with at least two alleles in a population, which may influence traits, drug response, or disease susceptibility.

## Genetic Profile

A set of genetic variants or DNA markers describing

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an individual, tumor, organism, or sample for diagnosis, risk assessment, identification, or research.

### **Genetic Recombination**

Exchange or rearrangement of DNA segments that creates new allele combinations during meiosis, repair, immune-cell development, or laboratory manipulation.

### **Genetic Susceptibility**

Inherited tendency to develop a disease or respond to an exposure, which usually modifies risk rather than determining outcome alone.

### **Genetic Technique**

A laboratory method used to detect, amplify, sequence, edit, compare, or otherwise analyze DNA, RNA, chromosomes, or gene expression.

### **Genetic Transcription**

Synthesis of an RNA copy from a DNA template by RNA polymerase, initiating expression of a gene.

### **Geniculate Body**

geniculate body is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Genital Edema**

Swelling of genital tissues from fluid accumulation caused by infection, inflammation, allergy, trauma, venous or lymphatic obstruction, or systemic disease.

### **Genital System**

genital system is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Genitourinary Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting genitourinary neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Genomic Instability**

An increased tendency for genetic alterations to accumulate, contributing to cancer development and progression.

### **Genomic Library**

genomic library is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Genomic Medicine**

Use of a person's genetic or genomic information to guide disease diagnosis, risk assessment, prevention, or treatment.

### **Genomics**

genomics is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Genotype Determination**

genotype determination is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gentamicin**

Gentamicin is an aminoglycoside antibiotic that binds the bacterial 30S ribosomal subunit and causes misreading of mRNA; nephrotoxicity and ototoxicity require dosing and level monitoring.

### **Gentamicin Sulfate**

A clinical condition or finding involving gentamicin sulfate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gentian Violet**

A purple antiseptic and dye with antifungal and antibacterial activity, used in selected topical applications but capable of irritating tissue and staining skin.

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### **Genu Recurvatum**

Hyperextension of the knee beyond the usual straight position, caused by laxity, deformity, muscle imbalance, neurologic disease, or injury.

### **Genus Dermatophilus**

genus dermatophilus is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Genus Dickeya**

genus dickeya is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Genus Leminorella**

genus leminorella is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Genus Saimiri**

genus saimiri is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Geophagia**

Persistent eating of soil or other nonfood substances; it may cause poisoning, infection, intestinal obstruction, or iron-deficiency anemia.

### **Geotrichum**

geotrichum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Geotrichum Klebahnii**

geotrichum klebahnii is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Geriatric Nursing**

Nursing care focused on the health, function, medication safety, cognition, mobility, and goals of older adults.

### **Germ Cell**

A reproductive cell or precursor that gives rise to sperm or eggs and carries genetic material to the next generation.

### **Germ Layer**

germ layer is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Germanium**

germanium is a microorganism or biological taxon; its clinical importance depends on the species, specimen, host, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Giant Cells**

Large cells formed by fusion of macrophages or abnormal cellular growth, seen in granulomatous inflammation, foreign-body reactions, and some tumors.

### **Giardia**

giardia is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Gigabecquerel**

gigabecquerel is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gill**

gill refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.



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### **Gimatecan**

A clinical condition or finding involving gimatecan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gingiva Disease**

A disorder of the gums, including plaque-induced gingivitis, periodontitis, infection, immune disease, recession, or tumor.

### **Gingival Hemorrhage**

Bleeding from gum tissue, commonly due to inflammation and plaque but also caused by trauma, periodontal disease, medicines, or bleeding disorders.

### **Gingival Infections**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving gingival infections; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Gingival Margin**

gingival margin is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Gingival Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting gingival neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Gingival Overgrowth**

gingival overgrowth is an anatomical, cellular, developmental, or physiological term; its clinical meaning depends on the structure, function, and surrounding findings.

### **Gingival Pocket**

gingival pocket is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Ginkgo Biloba**

A clinical condition or finding involving ginkgo

biloba. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ginseng Preparation**

ginseng preparation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Gizzard**

gizzard is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Glanders**

A biomedical term referring to glanders; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Glandular Stomach**

glandular stomach is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Gliclazide**

Gliclazide is a sulfonylurea for type 2 diabetes that stimulates pancreatic beta-cell insulin release; hypoglycaemia, weight gain, and dose accumulation in organ impairment are important considerations.

### **Glioblastoma Multiforme**

A neoplastic process affecting glioblastoma multiforme; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Gliocladium**

A biomedical term referring to gliocladium; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Gliosarcoma**

A neoplastic process affecting gliosarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

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### **Gliososis**

A reactive increase in glial cells after injury, infection, ischemia, or other damage to the central nervous system.

### **Glipizide**

Glipizide is a short-acting sulfonylurea that lowers blood glucose by stimulating insulin secretion from functioning pancreatic beta cells; hypoglycaemia is the principal adverse effect.

### **Globicatella**

globicatella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Globicatella Sanguinis**

A biomedical term referring to globicatella sanguinis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Globozoospermia**

A rare sperm disorder in which sperm heads are round and lack a normal acrosome, causing impaired fertilization and male infertility.

### **Globule Unit**

A small rounded particle or droplet used as a descriptive or measurement unit in laboratory, pharmaceutical, or biologic contexts; exact meaning depends on the source.

### **Globus Pallidus**

globus pallidus is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Glomerular Filtration**

glomerular filtration is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Glomerulomegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of kidney glomeruli, seen with diabetes, obesity-related hyperfiltration, congenital syndromes, or other causes of glomerular stress.

### **Glomerulonephritis Acute**

Sudden inflammation of the kidney glomeruli that can cause blood or protein in urine, edema, hypertension, and reduced kidney function.

### **Glossalgia**

Pain or burning of the tongue, with causes including trauma, infection, nutritional deficiency, neuropathy, medication, or burning-mouth syndrome.

### **Glossectomy**

Surgical removal of all or part of the tongue, performed for malignancies (most common), severe trauma, or macroglossia. Procedures range from partial glossectomy to total glossectomy. Speech and swallowing rehabilitation are often required.

### **Glossinidae**

The family of flies belonging to the genus Glossina, commonly known as tsetse flies. These insects are vectors of trypanosomes that cause African trypanosomiasis (sleeping sickness) in humans and nagana in animals.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tsetse flies

### **Glossopharyngeal Nerve**

glossopharyngeal nerve is a nerve pathway or nerve-related structure that carries signals between the nervous system and its target; symptoms depend on the site of involvement.

### **Glossoptosis**

Backward displacement of the tongue that can narrow the upper airway, particularly in infants with craniofacial disorders.

### **Glucan**

glucan is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environ-

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mental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glucarpidase**

An enzyme that rapidly breaks down methotrexate in the bloodstream and is used for toxic methotrexate concentrations when renal clearance is inadequate.

### **Glucocorticoid**

A corticosteroid hormone or medicine that regulates inflammation, immunity, metabolism, and stress responses; prolonged treatment has systemic adverse effects.

### **Gluconates**

gluconates is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glucose Transport**

glucose transport is a nutrition or dietary term; appropriate use depends on age, health status, allergies, intake, and medical treatment.

### **Glucose Transporter**

A membrane protein that moves glucose across a cell membrane; transporter defects or altered regulation can affect glucose metabolism.

### **Glucosinolate**

A clinical condition or finding involving glucosinolate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glucosylceramidase**

Glucosylceramidase is a lysosomal enzyme that hydrolyses glucosylceramide; inherited deficiency causes Gaucher disease with lipid-laden macrophages in organs such as spleen, liver, bone marrow, and bone.

### **Glucuronate**

A clinical condition or finding involving glucuronate.

Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glucuronic Acid**

A sugar acid used by the liver to conjugate bilirubin, drugs, hormones, and toxins, increasing their water solubility for excretion.

### **Glucuronide**

A clinical condition or finding involving glucuronide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glutamate Decarboxylase**

glutamate decarboxylase is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glutamate Receptor**

A neuronal receptor activated by glutamate, the major excitatory neurotransmitter, including NMDA, AMPA, kainate, and metabotropic receptor classes.

### **Glutamic Acid**

An amino acid that acts as a metabolic intermediate and neurotransmitter precursor; its charged form, glutamate, mediates most fast excitatory signaling in the brain.

### **Glutamine**

glutamine is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glutaral**

glutaral is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glutathione Disulfide**

glutathione disulfide is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends

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on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glutathione Transferase**

glutathione transferase is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Gluteal Muscle**

gluteal muscle is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### **Glyburide**

An oral sulfonylurea that stimulates pancreatic insulin release for type 2 diabetes; prolonged or severe hypoglycemia is an important risk.

### **Glyceraldehyde**

glyceraldehyde is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glyceride**

glyceride is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycerol**

glycerol is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycerol Kinase**

glycerol kinase is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycerophosphates**

glycerophosphates is a chemical, laboratory, genetic,

or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycerophospholipids**

The major membrane phospholipids built from glycerol, fatty acids, phosphate, and a polar head group, including phosphatidylcholine and phosphatidylethanolamine.

### **Glycerylphosphorylcholine**

glycerylphosphorylcholine is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycine**

glycine is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycine Receptor**

A ligand-gated chloride channel activated by glycine that mediates inhibitory neurotransmission, especially in the spinal cord and brainstem.

### **Glycocalyx**

glycocalyx is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycolates**

glycolates is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycolipid**

A lipid containing a carbohydrate group that contributes to cell membranes, recognition, signaling, and myelin structure.

### **Glycomics**

glycomics is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or en-

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vironmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycopeptide**

glycopeptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in glycopeptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Glycophorin**

glycophorin is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycoprotein**

A protein with covalently attached carbohydrate chains, important in receptors, antibodies, enzymes, mucus, cell adhesion, and extracellular matrix.

### **Glycopyrrolate**

glycopyrrolate is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycosaminoglycans**

glycosaminoglycans is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycoside**

glycoside is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycosphingolipid**

A membrane lipid containing ceramide and one or more sugars, involved in cell recognition, signaling, and nervous-system structure.

### **Glycosylation**

glycosylation is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycosylphosphatidylinositol**

glycosylphosphatidylinositol is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycosyltransferase**

glycosyltransferase is a chemical, laboratory, genetic, or environmental term; significance depends on the substance, method, concentration, route, or clinical context.

### **Glycyrrhetic Acid**

An active metabolite of licorice glycosides that inhibits 11-beta-hydroxysteroid dehydrogenase; excess exposure can cause hypertension, low potassium, and fluid retention.

### **Glycyrrhizic Acid**

The major saponin in licorice root that is converted to glycyrrhetic acid and can produce mineralocorticoid-like toxicity when consumed excessively.

### **Glyoxal**

A reactive dialdehyde formed in metabolism and food processing that can modify proteins and DNA and contribute to advanced glycation products.

### **Glyoxysome**

A clinical condition or finding involving glyoxysome. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glyphosate**

A broad-spectrum herbicide that inhibits plant EPSP synthase; concentrated exposure can irritate tissues and cause systemic poisoning, especially after ingestion.

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## Glyphosine

A chemical compound used experimentally or in agriculture; its medical significance depends on the specific formulation and exposure context.

## Gnathostoma

gnathostoma is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

## Gnathostoma Spinigerum

gnathostoma spinigerum is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

## Gnathostomiasis

A parasitic infection caused by *Gnathostoma* larvae acquired from undercooked freshwater fish or other hosts, producing migratory skin swellings or deeper neurologic or ocular disease.

## Goblet Cell

A mucus-secreting epithelial cell, abundant in the respiratory and intestinal tracts, that protects surfaces with a mucin-rich layer.

## Gold

A clinical condition or finding involving gold. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Gold Alloys

A clinical condition or finding involving gold alloys. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Golgi Cisternae

A clinical condition or finding involving golgi cisternae. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Gonad

A testis or ovary, an organ that produces reproduc-

tive cells and sex hormones.

## Gonad Disorder

A disease affecting testes or ovaries and causing abnormal reproductive-cell production, hormone secretion, development, fertility, or sexual function.

## Gonadal Agenesis

Congenital absence or severe underdevelopment of a gonad, resulting in impaired sex-hormone production and infertility or differences in sexual development.

## Gonadorelin

Synthetic gonadotropin-releasing hormone that stimulates pituitary release of luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone when given intermittently.

## Gonadotrophs

Anterior-pituitary cells that secrete luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone in response to gonadotropin-releasing hormone.

## Gonadotropin

A hormone, chiefly luteinizing hormone or follicle-stimulating hormone, that acts on the ovaries or testes to regulate gamete production and sex-hormone secretion.

## Gondoic Acid

A 20-carbon monounsaturated fatty acid found in some seed oils and incorporated into dietary and tissue lipids.

## Gordonia Aichiensis

A biomedical term referring to *gordonia aichiensis*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Gordonia Bacterium

*gordonia* bacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenic-



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ity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Gordonia Bronchialis**

A biomedical term referring to *gordonia bronchialis*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Gordonia Rubripertincta**

A biomedical term referring to *gordonia rubripertincta*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Gordonia Sputi**

A biomedical term referring to *gordonia sputi*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Gordonia Terrae**

A biomedical term referring to *gordonia terrae*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Goserelin**

A clinical condition or finding involving goserelin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gossypol**

A clinical condition or finding involving gossypol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gout Suppressants**

Medicines that lower uric-acid production or increase its excretion to prevent recurrent gout attacks and urate crystal deposition.

### **G-Quadruplexes**

A clinical condition or finding involving g-quadruplexes. Its defining features, causes, eval-

uation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gracilibacillus**

*gracilibacillus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Graft Versus Host**

Graft-versus-host disease occurs when immunocompetent donor T cells in an allogeneic transplant attack recipient tissues, especially skin, liver, and gastrointestinal tract; it may be acute or chronic.

### **Gramicidin**

gramicidin is a medical or biological concept whose definition and clinical significance depend on its characteristic features, setting, associated findings, and clinical context.

### **Gram-Positive Rods**

gram-positive rods is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Granisetron**

Granisetron is a selective 5-HT<sub>3</sub>-receptor antagonist used to prevent chemotherapy-, radiotherapy-, or surgery-related nausea and vomiting; headache, constipation, and QT prolongation can occur.

### **Granisetron Hydrochloride**

A medicine or chemical compound called granisetron hydrochloride. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Granulation Tissue**

granulation tissue is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

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## Granules

A clinical condition or finding involving granules. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Granulicatella

granulicatella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

## Granulicatella Adiacens

A biomedical term referring to granulicatella adiacens; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Granulicatella Elegans

A biomedical term referring to granulicatella elegans; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Granulocyte Count

granulocyte count is a diagnostic, imaging, research, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

## Granulocytic Sarcoma

A neoplastic process affecting granulocytic sarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Granulosa Cell

granulosa cell is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

## Granzyme

A clinical condition or finding involving granzyme. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Gravidity

gravidity is a developmental, genetic, reproductive, or family-related term describing a stage, trait, relationship, or pregnancy history; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

## Gravitropism

gravitropism is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

## Grimontia Hollisae

A biomedical term referring to grimontia hollisae; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Grip Strength

A clinical condition or finding involving grip strength. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Griseofulvin

Griseofulvin is an oral antifungal that deposits in newly formed keratin and disrupts dermatophyte mitosis, treating infections of skin, hair, and nails; treatment is prolonged and hepatic or drug-interaction risks apply.

## Gross Virus

gross virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Ground Substance

ground substance is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

## Groundwater

A clinical condition or finding involving groundwater. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## Group Therapy

A form of psychotherapy where a small group of individuals with similar issues meet to discuss, interact, and develop coping strategies under the guidance of a trained therapist. Used for depression, anxiety, substance use disorders, grief, and chronic illness. Benefits include peer support and shared experiences.

## Growth

The process of increasing in physical size and development, including physical, cognitive, and emotional maturation. In medicine, growth is monitored using growth charts and anthropometric measurements to assess health and development in children.

## Growth Cone

growth cone is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

## Growth Disorder

A clinical disorder or finding related to growth disorder; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

## Growth Inhibitor

growth inhibitor is a medical or biological concept whose definition and clinical significance depend on its characteristic features, setting, associated findings, and clinical context.

## Gtp Binding

gtp binding is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

## Guanazole

A medicine or chemical compound called guanazole. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Guanfacine

Guanfacine is a centrally acting alpha-2A adrenergic

agonist used for hypertension and, in extended-release form, ADHD; sedation, hypotension, bradycardia, and rebound hypertension after abrupt withdrawal are important risks.

## Guanine

Guanine is a purine nitrogenous base in DNA and RNA; it pairs with cytosine and is present in nucleotides such as GMP and GTP that support energy transfer and signaling.

## Guanosine

A clinical condition or finding involving guanosine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Guanosine Diphosphate

A clinical condition or finding involving guanosine diphosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Guanosine Monophosphate

A clinical condition or finding involving guanosine monophosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Guanosine Triphosphate

A clinical condition or finding involving guanosine triphosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Guanosinetriphosphatase

A clinical condition or finding involving guanosinetriphosphatase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Guanylate Cyclase

Guanylate cyclase is an enzyme that converts GTP to cyclic GMP, a second messenger involved in nitric oxide signaling, smooth-muscle relaxation, phototransduction, and intestinal fluid secretion.

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### Guide Device

guide device is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### Guided Imagery

guided imagery is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### Guilt

A clinical condition or finding involving guilt. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Gut Epithelium

gut epithelium is a tissue, cell, or body structure whose location and function help explain its role in normal physiology and disease.

### Gynatresia

A clinical condition or finding involving gynatresia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Gynecological Examination

gynecological examination is a diagnostic, imaging, research, or measurement term used to assess a condition or question; interpretation depends on the indication, method, and result.

### Gynecologist

gynecologist is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### Green Stool

Stool with a green color that may result from diet, food coloring, rapid intestinal transit, medicines, or infection.

### Groin Pain (Male)

Pain in the groin or adjacent lower abdomen, hip, or testicle in a male; causes include muscle strain, hernia, infection, urinary stones, or referred pain.

### Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor (GIST)

A tumor arising from specialized cells in the digestive tract, most often in the stomach or small intestine.

### Germ Cell Tumors

Tumors arising from cells that normally develop into eggs or sperm, occurring in the gonads or other parts of the body.

### Giardia Infection (Giardiasis)

An intestinal infection caused by Giardia parasites, commonly producing diarrhea, cramps, bloating, gas, and malabsorption.

### Golfer's Elbow (Medial Epicondylitis)

Overuse injury involving tendons on the inside of the elbow, causing pain and tenderness with gripping or wrist movement.

#### Synonyms:

Medial Epicondylitis

### Group B Strep Disease

Illness caused by group B Streptococcus bacteria, which can cause serious infections in newborns and infections in pregnant people or adults with medical risks.

### Galactocerebrosidase Deficiency

An inherited deficiency of the lysosomal enzyme galactocerebrosidase, associated with Krabbe disease and impaired myelin formation. See *Krabbe Disease*.

#### Synonyms:

Galactocerebrosidase deficiency; galactosylceramidase deficiency.

### GAD

Generalized Anxiety Disorder: a condition characterized by excessive, difficult-to-control anxiety

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and worry about multiple events or activities occurring more days than not for at least six months. Associated symptoms include restlessness, fatigue, difficulty concentrating, irritability, muscle tension, and sleep disturbance.

**Synonyms:**

Generalized Anxiety Disorder

**Gallbladder Inflammation**

Cholecystitis: inflammation of the gallbladder, most commonly caused by gallstones blocking the cystic duct. Presents with right upper quadrant pain, fever, nausea, and vomiting. Acute cholecystitis may require antibiotics and cholecystectomy.

**Synonyms:**

Cholecystitis

**Gambling, Compulsive**

Compulsive gambling (gambling disorder): a behavioral addiction characterized by persistent, difficult-to-control gambling despite harmful consequences. Involves preoccupation, increasing bets, unsuccessful attempts to stop, and gambling to escape distress. Assessment and structured behavioral and addiction treatment can help.

**Synonyms:**

Gambling disorder; pathological gambling

**Gastric Emptying, Delayed**

Gastroparesis: delayed gastric emptying without mechanical obstruction, causing early satiety, nausea, vomiting, bloating, and poor glucose control. Common causes include diabetes, post-surgical changes, and idiopathic causes. Diagnosed by gastric emptying scintigraphy.

**Synonyms:**

Gastroparesis

**Gastric Emptying, Rapid**

Dumping Syndrome: rapid gastric emptying where food moves too quickly from the stomach into the small intestine, causing nausea, vomiting, cramping, diarrhea, dizziness, and sweating after eating. Common after gastric surgery. Managed with dietary modifications.

**Synonyms:**

Dumping Syndrome

**Gastroenteritis, Viral**

Viral gastroenteritis (stomach flu): inflammation of the stomach and intestines caused by viruses such as norovirus, rotavirus, or adenovirus. Presents with diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal cramps, and dehydration. Usually self-limited.

**Synonyms:**

Viral gastroenteritis; stomach flu

**GBM**

Glioblastoma: the most aggressive primary brain tumor, classified as WHO grade IV astrocytoma. Characterized by rapid growth, necrosis, and microvascular proliferation. Presents with headaches, seizures, focal neurological deficits, and cognitive changes. Treatment includes surgery, radiation, and chemotherapy.

**Synonyms:**

Glioblastoma multiforme

**Gender Identity Disorder**

Gender Dysphoria: psychological distress resulting from incongruence between one's experienced gender and assigned gender at birth. Persists for  $\geq 6$  months and causes significant impairment. Onset in childhood (may resolve) or adolescence/adulthood (persistent).

**Synonyms:**

Gender Dysphoria

**German Measles**

Rubella: a contagious viral infection caused by rubella virus, characterized by fever, lymph-node enlargement, and a fine rash. Infection during pregnancy can harm the fetus, causing congenital rubella syndrome with cardiac, auditory, and developmental defects.

**Synonyms:**

Rubella

**Giant Lymph Node Hyperplasia**

Castleman Disease: a rare lymphoproliferative disorder characterized by non-cancerous overgrowth of

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lymph node tissue. May be unicentric (localized) or multicentric (systemic symptoms). Associated with HHV-8 and IL-6 overproduction. Treatment depends on subtype.

**Synonyms:**

Castleman Disease

**Glossodynia**

Burning Mouth Syndrome: a chronic pain condition characterized by a burning sensation in the mouth, often affecting the tongue, lips, and palate, without visible abnormalities. May be associated with dry mouth, altered taste, or tingling. Diagnosis is clinical after excluding other causes.

**Synonyms:**

Burning Mouth Syndrome

**Glucocerebrosidase Deficiency**

Gaucher Disease: an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase, leading to lipid accumulation in cells and possible enlargement of the spleen and liver, anemia, bone disease, or neurologic disease.

**Synonyms:**

Gaucher Disease

**Gluten-Sensitive Enteropathy**

Celiac Disease: an autoimmune disorder triggered by gluten ingestion in genetically susceptible individuals, causing damage to the small intestinal mucosa. Presents with diarrhea, bloating, weight loss, and malabsorption. Diagnosis by serology and intestinal biopsy.

**Synonyms:**

Celiac Disease; celiac sprue

**Grade IV Astrocytoma**

Glioblastoma: the most malignant primary brain tumor, characterized by rapid growth, necrosis, and microvascular proliferation. Presents with headaches, seizures, focal neurological deficits, and cognitive changes. Treatment includes surgery, radiation, and chemotherapy.

**Synonyms:**

Glioblastoma

**Gross Hematuria**

Visible blood in the urine, appearing pink, red, or brown. Causes include urinary tract infections, kidney stones, bladder or kidney cancer, trauma, and glomerular disease. Requires medical evaluation to determine the underlying cause.

**Synonyms:**

Visible hematuria

**Gum Disease, Gingivitis**

Gingivitis: inflammation of the gingiva (gums) without loss of supporting bone. Characterized by red, swollen, bleeding gums. Commonly caused by plaque accumulation. Reversible with good oral hygiene and professional cleaning.

**Synonyms:**

Gingivitis

**Gum Disease, Periodontitis**

Periodontitis: progressive inflammation and destruction of the supporting structures of the teeth, including the periodontal ligament and alveolar bone. Results from untreated gingivitis. Can lead to tooth loss. Requires professional treatment including scaling and root planing.

**Synonyms:**

Periodontitis

**Galactose-1-Phosphate Uridyltransferase Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess galactose-1-phosphate uridyltransferase blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

**Gallbladder Radionuclide Scan**

A clinical condition or finding involving gallbladder radionuclide scan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

**Gallbladder Removal - Laparoscopic - Discharge**

Post-operative care instructions following laparoscopic cholecystectomy, including wound care, pain



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management, dietary restrictions, activity limitations, signs of infection, and when to seek medical attention for complications.

**Synonyms:**

Laparoscopic cholecystectomy discharge

**Gallbladder Removal - Open - Discharge**

Post-operative care instructions following open cholecystectomy, including wound care, pain management, dietary restrictions, activity limitations, signs of infection, and when to seek medical attention for complications.

**Synonyms:**

Open cholecystectomy discharge

**Gallstones - Discharge**

Care instructions for patients discharged with gallstones not requiring immediate surgery, including dietary modifications (low-fat diet), pain management, warning signs of complications (jaundice, fever, severe pain), and follow-up scheduling for elective cholecystectomy.

**Synonyms:**

Biliary colic discharge; cholelithiasis discharge

**Gamma-Glutamyl Transferase (GGT)  
Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess gamma-glutamyl transferase (ggt) blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

**Gas – Flatulence**

Flatulence: the passage of gas from the digestive system through the rectum, commonly known as passing gas or farting. Normal physiological process caused by swallowed air and bacterial fermentation of undigested carbohydrates in the colon. Excessive gas may cause bloating, cramps, or social embarrassment.

**Synonyms:**

Flatulence; passing gas

**Gasoline Poisoning**

Toxic exposure to gasoline (petrol) through ingestion, inhalation, or skin contact. Symptoms include

nausea, vomiting, headache, dizziness, and central nervous system depression. Severe cases may cause chemical pneumonitis, seizures, or cardiac arrhythmias. Requires immediate medical attention.

**Synonyms:**

Petrol poisoning

**Gastric Bypass Surgery**

Bariatric surgical procedure that creates a small stomach pouch and reroutes the small intestine, combining restrictive and malabsorptive mechanisms. Indicated for severe obesity (BMI  $\geq 40$  or  $\geq 35$  with comorbidities). Results in significant weight loss and improvement in obesity-related conditions.

**Synonyms:**

Roux-en-Y gastric bypass; bariatric surgery

**Gastric Bypass Surgery - Discharge**

Post-operative care instructions following gastric bypass surgery, including dietary progression, activity restrictions, wound care, signs of complications (leak, infection, obstruction), medication management, and follow-up scheduling.

**Synonyms:**

Bariatric surgery discharge

**Gastric Culture**

Laboratory test to identify bacteria in the stomach, most commonly used to detect *Helicobacter pylori* infection. Specimens are obtained via endoscopic biopsy. Results guide antibiotic treatment for *H. pylori* eradication.

**Synonyms:**

*H. pylori* culture

**Gastric Suction**

Nasogastric tube placement for removal of gastric contents, used for decompression in bowel obstruction, preparation for surgery, or treatment of gastric dilatation. Also called nasogastric aspiration or gastric lavage.

**Synonyms:**

Nasogastric aspiration; gastric lavage

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## Gastric Tissue Biopsy And Culture

Endoscopic procedure to obtain tissue samples from the stomach lining for microscopic examination and bacterial culture. Used to diagnose gastritis, H. pylori infection, gastric cancer, and other gastric conditions.

### Synonyms:

Endoscopic gastric biopsy

## Gastrin Blood Test

Laboratory measurement of gastrin levels in the blood, used to evaluate suspected Zollinger-Ellison syndrome (gastrinoma), atrophic gastritis, or other causes of gastric acid hypersecretion. Levels are affected by proton pump inhibitors and fasting state.

### Synonyms:

Serum gastrin level

## Gastroesophageal Reflux - Discharge

Post-care instructions following treatment for gastroesophageal reflux disease (GERD), including lifestyle modifications, dietary changes, medication adherence, and when to seek medical attention for warning symptoms.

### Synonyms:

GERD discharge

## Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease - Children

GERD in pediatric patients: chronic reflux of stomach contents into the esophagus causing symptoms such as regurgitation, vomiting, feeding difficulties, irritability, and poor weight gain. May require positional management, dietary changes, and acid-suppressing medications.

### Synonyms:

Pediatric GERD; infant reflux

## Gastroesophageal Reflux In Infants

Gastroesophageal reflux in infants concerns gastroesophageal reflux in infants, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Gastrointestinal Diseases - Resources

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess gastrointestinal diseases - resources. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Gastrointestinal Fistula

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess gastrointestinal fistula. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Gastroschisis Repair

Surgical repair of gastroschisis, a congenital abdominal wall defect where intestines protrude through an opening near the umbilicus. Surgery involves returning the bowel to the abdomen and closing the defect. May require staged closure with silo placement.

### Synonyms:

Abdominal wall defect repair

## Gastrostomy Feeding Tube - Bolus

Technique for administering formula or nutrition directly into the stomach through a gastrostomy tube using a syringe. Includes hand-washing, flushing the tube, administering formula in small boluses, and flushing after feeding. Provides supplemental or complete nutrition.

### Synonyms:

G-tube bolus feeding

## Gastrostomy Feeding Tube - Pump - Child

Technique for continuous or intermittent tube feeding in pediatric patients using an enteral feeding pump. Provides controlled delivery of formula through a gastrostomy tube, allowing for adjustable rates and volume. Includes equipment setup, monitoring, and troubleshooting.

### Synonyms:

Pediatric G-tube pump feeding

## General Paresis

Neurosyphilis: a chronic meningoencephalitis caused by *Treponema pallidum* infection, present-

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ing with progressive cognitive decline, personality changes, psychiatric symptoms, and neurological deficits. Diagnosis is by CSF analysis and serology. Treatment with IV penicillin.

**Synonyms:**

General paresis of the insane; neurosyphilis

**Generalized Anxiety Disorder - Self-Care**

Self-management strategies for generalized anxiety disorder, including relaxation techniques, cognitive restructuring, regular exercise, sleep hygiene, limiting caffeine, and stress management. These complement professional treatment and help reduce anxiety symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

GAD self-management

**Generalized Anxiety Disorder In Children**

Excessive, difficult-to-control worry in children about multiple topics (school performance, health, family safety) occurring more days than not for at least 6 months. Associated with restlessness, fatigue, difficulty concentrating, irritability, muscle tension, and sleep disturbance. Treatment includes cognitive behavioral therapy and possibly medication.

**Synonyms:**

Pediatric GAD

**Genes**

Basic units of heredity composed of DNA sequences that encode functional products (proteins or RNA). Located at specific positions (loci) on chromosomes. Genes determine traits and can carry mutations that cause disease.

**Genetic Testing And Your Cancer Risk**

Genetic testing and your cancer risk involves toxic or environmental exposure to genetic testing and your cancer risk; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

**Genetically Modified Organisms - GMOs**

Genetically modified organisms - GMOs concerns genetically modified organisms - gmos, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning

depends on location, function, and patient context.

**Genital Herpes - Self-Care**

Self-management strategies for genital herpes, including antiviral medication adherence, avoiding sexual contact during outbreaks, managing symptoms with warm baths and loose clothing, and understanding triggers for recurrence.

**Genital Sores - Female**

Ulcers, blisters, or lesions on the female genitalia (vulva, vagina, cervix). Causes include sexually transmitted infections (herpes, syphilis, chancroid), dermatological conditions, trauma, or malignancy. Requires medical evaluation for diagnosis and treatment.

**Synonyms:**

Female genital ulcers

**Genital Sores - Male**

Ulcers, blisters, or lesions on the male genitalia (penis, scrotum, perianal area). Causes include sexually transmitted infections (herpes, syphilis, chancroid), dermatological conditions, trauma, or malignancy. Requires medical evaluation for diagnosis and treatment.

**Synonyms:**

Male genital ulcers

**Gestational Diabetes - Self-Care**

Self-management strategies for gestational diabetes, including blood glucose monitoring, dietary modifications (balanced meals, carbohydrate control), regular physical activity, medication adherence if prescribed, and monitoring for signs of complications.

**Gestational Diabetes Diet**

Dietary management of gestational diabetes, focusing on controlled carbohydrate intake, balanced meals, regular meal timing, and appropriate portions to maintain blood glucose levels within target ranges. May require consultation with a dietitian.

**Synonyms:**

GDM diet

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### Getting A Prescription Filled

The process of obtaining prescribed medications from a pharmacy, including presenting the prescription, insurance verification, payment, and receiving medication counseling. May involve prior authorization for certain medications.

**Synonyms:**

Prescription fulfillment

### Getting Out Of Bed After Surgery

Post-operative mobilization instructions, including techniques for safe transfer from bed to standing, use of assistive devices, wound protection, pain management during movement, and progressive activity goals to prevent complications like blood clots and pneumonia.

**Synonyms:**

Post-surgical mobilization

### Getting Support When Your Child Has Cancer

Resources and strategies for families coping with a child's cancer diagnosis, including emotional support, financial assistance, respite care, support groups, and connecting with other families facing similar challenges.

**Synonyms:**

Pediatric cancer family support

### Getting Your Home Ready - After The Hospital

Home preparation instructions following hospital discharge, including safety modifications, arranging for help, preparing meals, organizing medications, and creating a comfortable recovery space.

**Synonyms:**

Discharge home preparation

### Getting Your Home Ready - Knee Or Hip Surgery

Pre-surgical home preparation for knee or hip replacement, including removing tripping hazards, installing grab bars, arranging furniture for mobility, and preparing a recovery area on the main floor.

**Synonyms:**

Pre-surgical home preparation

### Getting Yourself Healthy Before Surgery

Pre-operative optimization strategies including smoking cessation, nutritional improvement, blood glucose control, medication management, and exercise to reduce surgical risks and improve recovery outcomes.

**Synonyms:**

Pre-operative optimization

### Gianotti-Crosti Syndrome

A childhood skin condition characterized by a papular or papulovesicular rash on the face, buttocks, and extremities, often following viral infections (EBV, hepatitis B, CMV). Self-limited, lasting 2-8 weeks. Also called papular acrodermatitis of childhood.

**Synonyms:**

Papular acrodermatitis of childhood

### Giant Congenital Nevus

A large pigmented skin lesion present at birth, typically exceeding 20 cm in diameter. Composed of melanocytes and may involve dermis, subcutaneous tissue, and underlying structures. Risk of melanoma transformation. May require surgical excision or monitoring.

**Synonyms:**

Giant pigmented nevus; garment nevus

### Give Your Heart A Workout

Cardiovascular exercise recommendations and guidelines for improving heart health through regular physical activity, including aerobic exercises, intensity targets, duration, and frequency to strengthen the heart and improve circulation.

**Synonyms:**

Cardiovascular exercise; heart-healthy exercise

### Giving An IM (Intramuscular) Injection

Technique for administering medication into muscle tissue using a needle and syringe. Common sites include deltoid, vastus lateralis, and ventrogluteal muscles. Proper technique includes site selection, needle insertion at 90 degrees, aspiration, and slow

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injection.

**Synonyms:**

Intramuscular injection technique

### **Giving An Insulin Injection**

Technique for administering insulin subcutaneously using a syringe or insulin pen. Includes site selection (abdomen, thigh, upper arm), rotation of injection sites, proper needle insertion, and blood glucose monitoring.

**Synonyms:**

Insulin administration technique

### **Glaze Poisoning**

Toxic exposure to ceramic or pottery glaze, which may contain lead, cadmium, or other heavy metals. Symptoms depend on the metal involved and may include abdominal pain, neurological symptoms, and organ damage. Requires medical evaluation and chelation therapy in severe cases.

**Synonyms:**

Ceramic glaze poisoning

### **Gleason Grading System**

A histological grading system for prostate cancer based on glandular pattern differentiation. Score ranges from 2-10, with higher grades indicating more aggressive cancer. Used to guide treatment decisions and predict prognosis.

**Synonyms:**

Gleason score; Gleason grade

### **Glomus Jugulare Tumor**

A paraganglioma arising from the jugular bulb in the temporal bone. Benign but locally aggressive. Presents with pulsatile tinnitus, hearing loss, and cranial nerve palsies. Treatment includes surgery, radiation, and embolization.

**Synonyms:**

Jugular paraganglioma

### **Glomus Tympanicum Tumor**

A paraganglioma arising from the glomus bodies on the promontory of the middle ear. Benign tumor causing pulsatile tinnitus and conductive hearing

loss. Diagnosis by otoscopy and imaging. Treatment includes surgery or observation.

**Synonyms:**

Middle ear paraganglioma

### **GLP-1 Agonists**

Glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonists: a class of medications used for type 2 diabetes and obesity. They stimulate insulin secretion, suppress glucagon release, slow gastric emptying, and promote satiety. Examples include semaglutide, liraglutide, and dulaglutide.

**Synonyms:**

GLP-1 receptor agonists; incretin mimetics

### **Glucagon Blood Test**

Laboratory measurement of glucagon levels in the blood, used to evaluate suspected glucagonoma, hypoglycemia, or other pancreatic endocrine disorders. Levels are affected by fasting, meals, and medications.

**Synonyms:**

Serum glucagon level

### **Glucose Screening Tests During Pregnancy**

Laboratory tests to detect gestational diabetes mellitus, including the oral glucose tolerance test (OGTT) and glucose challenge test (GCT). Usually performed between 24-28 weeks of gestation. Abnormal results require further evaluation and management.

**Synonyms:**

Gestational diabetes screening

### **Glucose Tolerance Test - Non-Pregnant**

Laboratory test measuring blood glucose levels after oral glucose administration to evaluate glucose metabolism and diagnose diabetes or prediabetes. Involves fasting, blood glucose measurement, ingestion of glucose solution, and serial blood draws over 2-3 hours.

**Synonyms:**

OGTT; oral glucose tolerance test



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### Glucose Urine Test

Laboratory test to detect glucose in the urine (glycosuria). Normally absent; presence indicates blood glucose exceeding renal threshold, suggesting diabetes mellitus or renal tubular dysfunction. May be detected by dipstick or laboratory analysis.

**Synonyms:**

Urinary glucose; glycosuria test

### Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase Test

Laboratory test to measure G6PD enzyme activity in red blood cells, used to diagnose G6PD deficiency. Important before prescribing certain medications (primaquine, dapsone) that can cause hemolytic anemia in deficient individuals.

**Synonyms:**

G6PD assay

### Glucuronyl Transferase

UDP-glucuronosyltransferase: a liver enzyme involved in phase II drug metabolism, catalyzing glucuronidation of bilirubin, drugs, and toxins to make them water-soluble for excretion. Deficiency causes Gilbert syndrome or Crigler-Najjar syndrome.

**Synonyms:**

UDP-glucuronosyltransferase; UGT

### Glycemic Index And Diabetes

The glycemic index (GI) ranks carbohydrate-containing foods by their effect on blood glucose levels. Low GI foods ( $\leq 55$ ) cause gradual glucose rise; high GI foods ( $\geq 70$ ) cause rapid spikes. Important for diabetes management and dietary planning.

**Synonyms:**

GI; glycemic index

### Going Home After A C-Section

Post-operative care instructions following cesarean delivery, including wound care, pain management, activity restrictions, signs of infection, breastfeeding support, and when to seek medical attention for complications.

**Synonyms:**

C-section discharge; cesarean section recovery

### Gram Stain Of Skin Lesion

Microscopic examination of a skin lesion specimen stained with Gram stain to identify bacteria. Useful for diagnosing bacterial skin infections and guiding antibiotic therapy. Results available within hours.

**Synonyms:**

Gram stain culture

### Gram Stain Of Tissue Biopsy

Microscopic examination of tissue biopsy specimen stained with Gram stain to identify bacteria. Used to diagnose tissue infections and guide antimicrobial therapy. May be performed alongside culture and histopathology.

**Synonyms:**

Tissue Gram stain

### Gram Stain Of Urethral Discharge

Microscopic examination of urethral discharge stained with Gram stain to identify bacteria, particularly *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*. Used to diagnose urethritis and sexually transmitted infections. Results help guide antibiotic treatment.

**Synonyms:**

Urethral Gram stain

### Grass Allergy

Hypersensitivity reaction to grass pollen, causing allergic rhinitis (hay fever) with symptoms including sneezing, nasal congestion, itchy eyes, and throat irritation. Seasonal, typically spring through fall. Treatment includes antihistamines, nasal corticosteroids, and allergen avoidance.

**Synonyms:**

Hay fever; seasonal allergic rhinitis

### Grass And Weed Killer Poisoning

Toxic exposure to herbicides containing glyphosate, 2,4-D, or other chemicals. Symptoms range from mild skin and eye irritation to severe gastrointestinal, respiratory, and neurological effects depending on the product and exposure route. Requires immediate medical attention.

**Synonyms:**

Herbicide poisoning; pesticide poisoning



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### Greater Trochanteric Pain Syndrome

Pain over the lateral hip centered on the greater trochanter, commonly caused by tendinopathy or bursitis of the gluteal tendons. Presents with lateral hip pain worse with walking, climbing stairs, or lying on the affected side. Treatment includes physical therapy and activity modification.

#### Synonyms:

Trochanteric bursitis; gluteal tendinopathy

### Groin Lump

A palpable mass in the inguinal region, which may represent lymphadenopathy, hernia, cyst, tumor, or other pathology. Requires medical evaluation to determine the cause and appropriate treatment.

#### Synonyms:

Inguinal mass

### Groin Pain

Pain in the inguinal region, which may originate from musculoskeletal, genitourinary, gastrointestinal, or vascular causes. Common causes include muscle strain, hernia, lymphadenopathy, and hip pathology. Requires clinical evaluation for diagnosis.

#### Synonyms:

Inguinal pain

### Gross Motor Control

The ability to use large muscle groups for coordinated movements such as walking, running, jumping, and maintaining posture. Develops progressively from infancy through childhood and is assessed as part of developmental milestones.

#### Synonyms:

Large motor skills

### Group B Streptococcal Septicemia Of The Newborn

Serious bloodstream infection caused by Group B Streptococcus (GBS) in neonates, typically acquired during birth. Presents with fever, lethargy, poor feeding, and respiratory distress. Requires prompt antibiotic treatment and supportive care.

#### Synonyms:

Neonatal GBS sepsis

### Group B Streptococcus - Pregnancy

Colonization with Group B Streptococcus (GBS) during pregnancy, which can cause neonatal sepsis, pneumonia, and meningitis during delivery. Routine screening at 36-37 weeks gestation identifies colonized women who receive intrapartum antibiotic prophylaxis.

#### Synonyms:

GBS screening; intrapartum GBS prophylaxis

### Growth Hormone Deficiency - Children

Insufficient growth hormone (GH) production in children, resulting in short stature, delayed bone age, and reduced growth velocity. Causes include congenital anomalies, tumors, radiation, or idiopathic. Diagnosis involves GH stimulation tests. Treatment with recombinant GH.

#### Synonyms:

Pediatric GH deficiency

### Growth Hormone Stimulation Test

Laboratory tests to evaluate growth hormone (GH) secretion by stimulating the pituitary gland with insulin, arginine, glucagon, or clonidine. Used to diagnose GH deficiency when random GH levels are inconclusive. Peak GH <10 ng/mL suggests deficiency.

#### Synonyms:

GH stimulation test

### Growth Hormone Suppression Test

Laboratory test to evaluate excessive growth hormone (GH) secretion, typically using oral glucose tolerance. In normal individuals, glucose suppresses GH to <1 ng/mL. Failure to suppress suggests acromegaly or gigantism.

#### Synonyms:

GH suppression test; oral glucose tolerance test for acromegaly

### Growth Hormone Test

Laboratory measurement of growth hormone (GH) levels in the blood, used to evaluate GH deficiency

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or excess. Random GH levels have limited utility; stimulation or suppression tests are more informative.

**Synonyms:**

GH level; serum growth hormone

**Gum Biopsy**

Histological examination of gingival tissue obtained by biopsy, used to diagnose gingival diseases, infections, or malignancies. May involve excisional or incisional biopsy techniques.

**Synonyms:**

Gingival biopsy

**Gumma**

A soft, non-cancerous granulomatous lesion occurring in tertiary syphilis, characterized by central necrosis surrounded by inflammatory cells. Can affect any organ but commonly occurs in skin, bone, and liver. Treatment with antibiotics.

**Synonyms:**

Syphilitic gumma

**Gums - Swollen**

Gingival swelling: enlargement of the gum tissue, which may be caused by inflammation (gingivitis, periodontitis), infection, medications (phenytoin, cyclosporine), systemic diseases, or allergic reactions. May cause pain, bleeding, and difficulty eating.

**Synonyms:**

Swollen gums; gingival enlargement

**Gunshot Wounds - Aftercare**

Post-operative care instructions following gunshot wound treatment, including wound care, medication management, signs of infection, activity restrictions, and follow-up appointments for wound assessment and rehabilitation.

**Synonyms:**

Ballistic trauma aftercare

**Gallbladder Pain (Gall Bladder Pain)**

Biliary colic: pain caused by gallstones temporarily blocking the cystic duct. Characterized by severe, steady right upper quadrant pain lasting 30 minutes

to several hours, often after fatty meals. May be accompanied by nausea and vomiting.

**Synonyms:**

Biliary colic; gallstone pain Pain Gallbladder (Gallbladder Pain (Gall Bladder Pain))

**Gastroenteritis (Stomach Flu)**

Viral gastroenteritis: inflammation of the stomach and intestines caused by viruses such as norovirus, rotavirus, or adenovirus. Presents with diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal cramps, and dehydration. Usually self-limited.

**Synonyms:**

Stomach flu; viral gastroenteritis

**Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)**

Chronic condition where stomach contents repeatedly flow back into the esophagus, causing symptoms such as heartburn, regurgitation, chest pain, and esophageal damage. Managed with lifestyle changes, medications, and possibly surgery.

**Synonyms:**

GERD; acid reflux disease Acid Reflux (Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)) Chronic Acid Reflux

**GBS (Group B Strep)**

Group B Streptococcus: bacteria that can colonize the gastrointestinal and genital tracts, potentially causing serious infections in newborns during delivery. Routine screening in pregnancy guides intrapartum antibiotic prophylaxis.

**Synonyms:**

Group B Streptococcus; GBS colonization

**Genital Herpes (Genital Herpes In Women Overview)**

Herpes simplex virus infection of the female genitalia, causing painful blisters or ulcers. May be asymptomatic. Antiviral treatment reduces symptoms and transmission. Pregnancy requires obstetric planning due to risk of neonatal infection.

**Synonyms:**

Genital herpes in women

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### **Giant Cell Arterit (Giant Cell Arteritis (GCA Or Temporal Arteritis))**

Large-vessel vasculitis affecting adults >50, involving cranial branches of the carotid arteries. Presents with new-onset headache, scalp tenderness, jaw claudication, and visual disturbances. Risk of vision loss without treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Giant cell arteritis; temporal arteritis

### **Giant Cell Arteritis (GCA Or Temporal Arteritis)**

Inflammation of large and medium-sized arteries, predominantly affecting the temporal and ophthalmic arteries. Characterized by headache, visual symptoms, jaw claudication, and elevated ESR. Diagnosis by temporal artery biopsy. Treatment with high-dose corticosteroids.

#### **Synonyms:**

Temporal arteritis; Horton disease

### **Giant Platelet Syndrome (Bernard-Soulier Disease)**

An inherited platelet disorder caused by deficiency of glycoprotein Ib/IX/V complex, resulting in large platelets and impaired platelet adhesion. Presents with mucocutaneous bleeding, thrombocytopenia, and giant platelets on blood smear.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bernard-Soulier syndrome

### **Gingivitis Contagious (Is Gingivitis Contagious)**

Gingivitis itself is not directly contagious, but the bacteria that cause it (particularly *Porphyromonas gingivalis*) can be transmitted through saliva. Poor oral hygiene is the primary risk factor. Prevention focuses on personal oral care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Gingivitis transmission

### **Glands Swollen Lymph (Swollen Lymph Nodes)**

Lymphadenopathy: enlargement of lymph nodes, usually in response to infection, inflammation, or malignancy. Common locations include neck,

armpits, and groin. Most cases are benign and self-limited. Persistent or unexplained enlargement requires evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphadenopathy; swollen lymph nodes

### **Glands Swollen Nodes (Swollen Lymph Nodes)**

Enlarged lymph nodes: palpable increase in lymph node size, typically >1 cm, caused by immune activation, infection, autoimmune disease, or malignancy. Usually tender and mobile in benign causes. Fixed or hard nodes raise concern for malignancy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphadenopathy; enlarged lymph nodes

### **Gluten Sensitivity (Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance))**

Adverse symptoms triggered by gluten ingestion in individuals without celiac disease or wheat allergy. Symptoms include bloating, abdominal pain, diarrhea, and fatigue. Diagnosis is by exclusion. Management involves gluten avoidance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nonceliac gluten sensitivity; NCGS

### **Gout (Gouty Arthritis)**

Inflammatory arthritis caused by deposition of monosodium urate crystals in joints due to hyperuricemia. Presents with acute, severe joint pain (often the big toe), swelling, redness, and warmth. Treatment includes NSAIDs, colchicine, corticosteroids, and urate-lowering therapy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Gouty arthritis; crystal arthropathy Arthritis Gout (Gout (Gouty Arthritis))

### **GPA (Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis)**

A systemic vasculitis affecting small to medium vessels, characterized by necrotizing granulomatous inflammation of the respiratory tract and glomerulonephritis. Presents with sinusitis, pulmonary nodules, and renal involvement. Associated with c-ANCA/PR3 antibodies.

#### **Synonyms:**

Granulomatosis with polyangiitis; Wegener granulo-

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### **Graft Versus Host Disease (GVHD)**

A condition occurring after allogeneic stem cell or bone marrow transplantation where donor immune cells attack the recipient's tissues. Can be acute (within 100 days) or chronic (after 100 days). Affects skin, liver, and gastrointestinal tract.

**Synonyms:**  
GVHD

### **Grief (Loss, Grief, And Bereavement)**

The natural emotional response to loss, encompassing the process of coping with the death of a loved one or other significant losses. Includes grief (emotional response), loss (the event), and bereavement (the period of mourning). May involve physical, emotional, social, and spiritual dimensions.

**Synonyms:**  
Bereavement; mourning

### **Gum Problems**

Gum problems include inflammation, bleeding, recession, ulcers, infection, trauma, and growths. Causes include plaque, tobacco, dry mouth, medicines, nutritional or immune disease, and poorly fitting appliances; persistent lesions or bleeding need dental assessment.

### **GVHD (Graft Versus Host Disease (GVHD))**

A condition occurring after allogeneic stem cell or bone marrow transplantation where donor immune cells attack the recipient's tissues. Can be acute (within 100 days) or chronic (after 100 days). Affects skin, liver, and gastrointestinal tract. Prevention includes immunosuppressive prophylaxis.

**Synonyms:**  
Graft Versus Host Disease

### **G (Gram)**

A unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a kilogram; medication doses and laboratory measurements are often expressed in grams or smaller metric units.

### **Gain-Of-Function Mutation**

A genetic change that increases a gene product's activity, gives it a new activity, or causes it to be expressed in an abnormal way; its effects depend on the gene and tissue involved.

### **Galeophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of sharks that causes significant distress or avoidance.

### **Gallbladder Absence**

Congenital absence or surgical removal of the gallbladder; without a gallbladder, bile flows directly from the liver into the intestine.

### **Gallop Rhythm**

An extra heart sound producing a three- or four-beat cadence, usually from an S3 or S4; it can reflect altered ventricular filling or cardiac disease.

### **GALT**

Abbreviation for gut-associated lymphoid tissue, immune tissue in the gastrointestinal tract that samples intestinal contents and helps defend against pathogens.

### **Gamete Intrafallopian Transfer (GIFT)**

An assisted-reproduction procedure in which eggs and sperm are placed into a fallopian tube so fertilization can occur in the body; it is now used less often than in-vitro fertilization.

### **Gamma Hydroxybutyrate (GHB)**

A central-nervous-system depressant that can cause sedation, confusion, respiratory depression, coma, or death in overdose; it is also a drug of misuse.

### **Gas Chromatography (GC)**

An analytical method that vaporizes and separates volatile compounds in a gas stream, allowing their identification or measurement, often with mass spectrometry.

### **Gas Exchange**

The movement of oxygen and carbon dioxide be-

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tween air and blood in the lungs and between blood and tissues, essential for cellular respiration.

### **Gastroesophageal**

Relating to the stomach and esophagus, such as the gastroesophageal junction or gastroesophageal reflux.

### **GBV-C**

Abbreviation for GB virus C, also called human pegivirus, a blood-borne virus that can persist in people but is not established as a cause of chronic hepatitis.

### **GD**

In the RxList medical-dictionary context, abbreviation for Gaucher disease, an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase.

### **Gelineau Syndrome**

Another name for narcolepsy, a sleep disorder characterized by excessive daytime sleepiness and, in many patients, cataplexy, sleep paralysis, or vivid hallucinations around sleep.

### **Generic**

Describing a medicine by its active ingredient rather than a brand name; an approved generic drug must meet applicable standards for quality and therapeutic equivalence to its reference product.

### **Generic Name, Drug**

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to generic name, drug; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Genesis**

Origin, formation, or development, as in the genesis of a disease or organ.

### **Genetic Disease**

A disorder caused in whole or in part by changes in genetic material; it may be inherited, arise anew,

or result from chromosome or mitochondrial abnormalities.

### **Genital**

Relating to the reproductive organs or external sexual structures.

### **Genitourinary (GU)**

Relating to the urinary system and the reproductive organs, which share developmental and anatomical relationships.

### **Genu**

The knee or a knee-shaped part of an anatomical structure; the term also describes a bend, such as the genu of the corpus callosum.

### **Gephyrophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of bridges or of crossing them that causes significant distress or avoidance.

### **Gerascophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of aging or growing old that causes distress or avoidance.

### **Geriatric Medicine**

The medical specialty focused on the health, function, diseases, medications, and goals of older adults, often using comprehensive and coordinated care.

### **Gesell Developmental Schedules**

Standardized developmental assessment schedules that describe expected motor, language, adaptive, and social milestones in children; they support screening but do not by themselves diagnose a disorder.

### **Gestation Period**

The time from conception to birth or, clinically, from the last menstrual period to delivery; human pregnancy is usually about 40 weeks from the last menstrual period.

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## **GI**

Abbreviation for gastrointestinal, relating to the digestive tract from the mouth through the anus and its associated organs.

## **Giant Hypertrophic Gastritis**

Severe enlargement and thickening of the stomach's mucosal folds, classically associated with Ménétrier disease, which can cause protein loss, abdominal symptoms, and increased gastric-cancer risk.

## **Giant Platelet Syndrome**

A disorder characterized by unusually large platelets, often with a low platelet count and impaired clotting; inherited examples include Bernard–Soulier syndrome and MYH9-related disease.

## **Ginseng**

A group of plants whose roots are used in traditional medicine and dietary supplements; products vary in composition and may interact with medicines or affect blood glucose and clotting.

## **Glabella**

The smooth area of the forehead between the eyebrows and above the bridge of the nose.

## **Gliadin**

A group of wheat storage proteins that, together with glutenin, form gluten; gliadin peptides trigger the immune response in celiac disease.

## **Glial Cell**

A non-neuronal cell that supports, nourishes, insulates, and regulates neurons; examples include astrocytes, oligodendrocytes, microglia, and Schwann cells.

## **Globus**

A persistent or intermittent sensation of a lump or tightness in the throat without a true obstructing mass, often called globus pharyngeus.

## **Glossal**

Relating to the tongue.

## **Glu**

Commonly an abbreviation for glucose in laboratory or clinical notes; in biochemical notation, Glu can also denote the amino acid glutamic acid, so context matters.

## **Gluconacetobacter Liquefaciens**

An acetic-acid bacterium found mainly in environmental and plant-associated settings; it is not a common human pathogen.

## **Gluteal**

Relating to the buttock or the gluteal muscles, which extend and rotate the hip and help stabilize the pelvis.

## **Glycohemoglobin**

Hemoglobin with glucose chemically attached to it; glycated hemoglobin A1c reflects average blood glucose over roughly the preceding two to three months.

## **Gm (Gram)**

An abbreviation for gram, a metric unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a kilogram.

## **Goitrogenic Foods**

Foods or food components that can interfere with thyroid hormone production or iodine use under some conditions; risk depends on intake, preparation, iodine status, and thyroid health.

## **Good Samaritan**

A person who voluntarily helps someone in an emergency, especially by providing immediate aid before professional responders arrive.

## **Good Samaritan Law**

A law that may protect a person who provides reasonable emergency assistance from certain civil claims, subject to jurisdiction-specific conditions and exceptions such as gross negligence.

## **Goose Bump**

A small raised area around a hair follicle caused by



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contraction of tiny arrector pili muscles, commonly in response to cold, fear, or strong emotion.

### **Gooseflesh**

Another term for goose bumps, the temporary raised appearance of skin caused by piloerection.

### **Gouty Arthritis**

Inflammatory arthritis caused by deposition of monosodium urate crystals in and around joints, producing sudden episodes of severe pain, swelling, warmth, and redness.

### **Gower Syndrome (Situational Syncope)**

A form of reflex syncope, also called vasovagal or vasodepressor syncope, in which a trigger causes a fall in blood pressure and sometimes heart rate, briefly reducing brain perfusion.

### **GPO**

Abbreviation for group purchasing organization, an organization that combines buyers' purchasing power to negotiate prices and contracts for medicines, supplies, or services.

### **Gram (Measure)**

A metric unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a kilogram or approximately 15.4 grains.

### **Gram Calorie (Calorie)**

A small calorie is the energy needed to raise 1 gram of water by 1 degree Celsius; the dietary Calorie, written with a capital C, is a kilocalorie equal to 1,000 small calories.

### **Gram-Negative**

Describing bacteria with a thin peptidoglycan cell wall and an outer membrane containing lipopolysaccharide; they stain pink or red with the Gram stain.

### **Gram-Positive**

Describing bacteria with a thick peptidoglycan cell wall that retains crystal violet during Gram staining and therefore appears purple.

### **Grand Multipara**

A person who has given birth five or more times beyond the gestational threshold used to count parity; definitions can vary by obstetric system.

### **Grand Rounds**

An educational medical conference in which clinicians present a case, diagnosis, management, or clinical topic to a professional audience.

### **Granular Leukocyte**

A granulocyte, a white blood cell containing cytoplasmic granules; the main types are neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils.

### **Granulation**

The formation of new vascular connective tissue during wound healing, producing moist red or pink granulation tissue made of capillaries, fibroblasts, and extracellular matrix.

### **Granulocytopenia**

An abnormally low number of granulocytes, especially neutrophils, which can increase susceptibility to bacterial and fungal infection.

### **Granulomatous Colitis**

Inflammation of the colon in which granulomas are found on tissue examination, often associated with Crohn disease but also possible with infections or other inflammatory conditions.

### **Gray Baby Syndrome**

A serious form of chloramphenicol toxicity in newborns, caused by immature drug metabolism and characterized by abdominal distension, vomiting, cyanosis or gray skin color, cardiovascular collapse, and potentially death.

### **Gray's Anatomy**

A major illustrated human-anatomy reference book, first published in 1858 by Henry Gray and Henry Vandyke Carter and subsequently revised in many editions.

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### Gtt.

An abbreviation from the Latin *guttae*, meaning drops; because abbreviations can be misread, prescriptions should state liquid doses clearly.

### Guevedoces

A term used in the Dominican Republic for individuals with 46,XY differences in sex development caused by 5-alpha-reductase type 2 deficiency; they may have female-appearing or ambiguous external genitalia at birth and increased virilization at puberty.

### Gustatory Sweating

Sweating triggered by eating or thinking about food, usually over the cheek or temple after injury or surgery involving the parotid region; it is also called Frey syndrome.

### Guthrie Test

Guthrie test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### Gymnophobia

An excessive or persistent fear of nudity or of seeing others naked that causes significant distress or avoidance.

### Gyne-

A combining form meaning woman or female, as in gynecology.

### Gynecoid Pelvis

A commonly described pelvic shape with a rounded inlet, relatively broad dimensions, and a spacious outlet; it is associated with typical female pelvic anatomy but individual variation is substantial.

### Gynephobia

An excessive or persistent fear or aversion toward women that causes significant distress or avoidance.

### Genitourinary Tract

The combined urinary and reproductive organs and

their associated ducts.

### Gigli Saw

A flexible wire saw used to cut bone, especially during selected orthopedic or amputation procedures.

### Gleason Tumor Grade

A histopathologic grade of prostate adenocarcinoma based on the architectural pattern of the tumor glands; it contributes to the Gleason score and Grade Group.

### Group B Streptococcal Infection In Pregnancy

Maternal colonization or infection with *Streptococcus agalactiae*, which can be transmitted to the newborn during labor and cause serious early-onset infection. Screening and intrapartum management reduce neonatal risk.

### Growth Plate Fractures

Injuries involving the cartilage growth plates at the ends of growing children's bones, with possible effects on future bone growth.

### Greater Vestibular Glands

Paired glands near the vaginal opening that secrete mucus into the vestibule, contributing to lubrication. They are also called Bartholin glands.

#### Synonyms:

Bartholin glands; greater vestibular glands

### Gaits

Gaits is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### Gallstone

A solid concretion formed from bile components within the gallbladder or biliary tract, usually composed mainly of cholesterol, pigment, or a mixture. It may be asymptomatic or obstruct the cystic or common bile duct, causing biliary colic, cholecystitis, pancreatitis, cholangitis, or jaundice.

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### **Gallstone Pancreatitis**

Acute pancreatitis caused by a gallstone transiently obstructing the ampulla, where the bile duct and pancreatic duct empty into the duodenum. It typically causes sudden persistent upper-abdominal pain with raised pancreatic enzymes; severity assessment and evaluation for retained common-bile-duct stones are required.

### **Galvanocautery**

Galvanocautery is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

### **Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid (GABA)**

Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid (GABA) is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Gamma-Benzene Hexachloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving gamma-benzene hexachloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gamma-Interferon**

A clinical condition or finding involving gamma-interferon. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gamma Knife**

Gamma Knife is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gamma-Ray Therapy**

Gamma-Ray Therapy is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Ganglionectomy**

Ganglionectomy is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Ganglionic Blockers**

Ganglionic Blockers is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gargatism**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gargatism; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gargoylism**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gargoylism; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Garré'S Osteomyelitis**

A clinical disorder or finding related to garré's osteomyelitis; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gasserian Ganglion**

Gasserian Ganglion is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gastric Analysis**

Gastric Analysis is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gastric Flu**

A clinical condition or finding involving gastric flu. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Gastric Lavage**

Gastric Lavage is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gastromalacia**

Gastromalacia is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gastropathy**

Gastropathy is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gastroplasty**

Gastroplasty is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gaultheria Oil**

Gaultheria Oil is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Geiger Counter**

Geiger Counter is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gelselenium**

Gelselenium is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Genetic Code**

Genetic Code is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Genetic Counselling**

Genetic Counselling is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Genito-Urinary Medicine**

A medicine or chemical compound called genito-urinary medicine. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Gentian**

A clinical condition or finding involving gentian. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Geophagy**

A clinical condition or finding involving geophagy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gerontocracy**

A clinical condition or finding involving gerontocracy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gestalt Psychology**

A clinical condition or finding involving gestalt psychology. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gibraltar Fever**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gibraltar fever; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gilbert's Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gilbert's syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

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### **Gilles De La Tourette Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gilles de la tourette syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Girdle Pain**

Girdle Pain is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Githism**

A clinical disorder or finding related to githism; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Glandular Fever**

Glandular Fever is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Glass Eye**

Glass Eye is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

### **Glasses**

A clinical condition or finding involving glasses. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glial Cells**

Glial Cells is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Glibenclamide**

Glibenclamide is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Glimepiride**

Glimepiride is a medicine or pharmacologic product;

its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Globus Hystericus**

A clinical condition or finding involving globus hystericus. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glomerular Filtration Rate (GFR)**

Glomerular Filtration Rate (GFR) is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Glucosuria**

A clinical condition or finding involving glucosuria. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glue Ear**

Glue Ear is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

### **Glutaric Aciduria**

A clinical disorder or finding related to glutaric aciduria; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gluten Enteropathy**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gluten enteropathy; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Celiac Disease (Gluten Enteropathy)

### **Gluteus**

Gluteus is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

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### **Glycererol**

A clinical condition or finding involving glycererol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Glyceryl Trinitrate**

Glyceryl Trinitrate is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Glycogen Storage Diseases**

A clinical disorder or finding related to glycogen storage diseases; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gnathic**

Gnathic is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gnathion**

Gnathion is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gnathitis**

Gnathitis is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gnathoplasty**

Gnathoplasty is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gnawing Pain**

A biomedical term referring to gnawing pain; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Goitre**

A clinical disorder or finding related to goitre; evaluation

identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gold Therapy**

Gold Therapy is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Golden Hour**

Golden Hour is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gomori's Stain**

Gomori's Stain is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gonadotrophin**

Gonadotrophin is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gonadotrophin-Releasing Hormone (GnRH)**

Gonadotrophin-Releasing Hormone (GnRH) is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gonadotrophin-Releasing Factors**

Gonadotrophin-Releasing Factors is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gonococcal**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gonococcal; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.



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### **Gonococcus**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gonococcus; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gonorrhoea**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gonorrhoea; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Goodpasture's Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to goodpasture's syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Goose-Skin**

Goose-Skin is an anatomical or physiologic term describing a body structure or function; its clinical meaning depends on its location, role, and associated findings.

### **Gorget**

A clinical condition or finding involving gorget. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gornall's Test**

Gornall's Test is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gorlin's Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gorlin's syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Gossypium**

A clinical condition or finding involving gossypium. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gott's Shunt**

Gott's Shunt is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gougerot-Carteaud Syndrome**

A clinical disorder or finding related to gougerot-carteaud syndrome; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Graefe's Sign**

A clinical condition or finding involving graefe's sign. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gram's Stain**

Gram's Stain is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Granular**

A clinical condition or finding involving granular. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Grasp Reflex**

Grasp Reflex is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gravida**

A clinical condition or finding involving gravida. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gravity**

A clinical condition or finding involving gravity. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Green Blindness**

A clinical disorder or finding related to green blind-

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ness; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Green Sickness**

A clinical disorder or finding related to green sickness; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Grey Ankle Phenomenon**

A clinical condition or finding involving grey ankle phenomenon. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Grey Matter**

Grey Matter is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Grifulvin**

Grifulvin is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Groove**

Groove is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Ground Itch**

A clinical disorder or finding related to ground itch; evaluation identifies the underlying mechanism, affected site, severity, and relevant complications.

### **Group Practice**

A clinical condition or finding involving group practice. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Guanethidine**

Guanethidine is a medicine or pharmacologic product; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Guinea Worm**

A clinical condition or finding involving guinea worm. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Gummata**

Gummata is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gum**

Gum is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gunning's Splint**

Gunning's Splint is a diagnostic test, laboratory method, imaging technique, measurement, or treatment procedure used to answer a clinical question; results depend on method and context.

### **Gustatory**

Gustatory is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gut**

Gut is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Guttae**

Guttae is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Guttural**

Guttural is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

### **Gynaecology**

Gynaecology is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

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## Gynecic

Gynecic is an anatomical structure or physiologic function; its location, mechanism, and associated findings determine its clinical significance.

## Gated Blood Pool Scan

A radionuclide cardiac study, also called radionuclide ventriculography or MUGA, that uses ECG-gated images of labeled blood to measure ventricular ejection fraction and assess ventricular wall motion. It is used selectively when quantitative ventricular function is needed.

## Generalised

Widespread or involving multiple regions of the body rather than being confined to a single localized site.

## Gonadotropins

Hormones that act on the gonads. In humans, the pituitary gonadotropins are follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) and luteinizing hormone (LH), which regulate gamete production and sex-hormone secretion.

## GN

Alternate index label; see *Glomerulonephritis*.

## Glucocorticoid-Induced Osteoporosis

Bone loss and increased fracture risk caused or accelerated by prolonged or high-dose glucocorticoid treatment; risk depends on dose, duration, baseline bone health, and other factors.

## Genotype-Phenotype Correlation

The relationship between a person's genetic makeup and the observable features, severity, age of onset, or clinical course of a condition; correlations may be incomplete because other genetic and environmental factors contribute.

## Grover Disease

A transient or recurrent acantholytic dermatosis causing itchy red papules or papulovesicles, usually on the trunk of middle-aged or older adults; heat, sweating, and occlusion may aggravate it.

## Granular Cell Tumor Of The Breast

An uncommon tumor showing Schwann-cell differentiation that can occur in the breast and mimic carcinoma clinically or on imaging. Histologic examination distinguishes it from malignancy; most are benign.

## Granulomatous Mastitis

A chronic inflammatory breast disease characterized by noncaseating granulomas after other causes, especially infection and sarcoidosis, have been excluded. It may present as a painful mass, abscesses, or draining sinuses.

## Gallbladder Duplication

A rare congenital anomaly in which two gallbladder structures develop, with either separate or shared ducts. It may be incidental or associated with gallstones, inflammation, or bile-duct injury risk during surgery; preoperative imaging helps define the anatomy.

## Gallbladder Mucocele

Another name for hydrops of the gallbladder: distension caused by cystic-duct obstruction and accumulation of mucus or watery secretions, commonly from an impacted gallstone.

## Gastric Adenocarcinoma

The most common malignant epithelial tumor of the stomach, arising from gastric mucosa and associated with factors such as *Helicobacter pylori* infection, chronic atrophic gastritis, intestinal metaplasia, and hereditary syndromes.

## Goblet Cell Adenocarcinoma

A distinctive appendiceal adenocarcinoma composed of goblet-like mucinous cells, formerly called goblet cell carcinoid. It can spread within the peritoneum or to the ovaries and is managed according to grade, stage, and dissemination.

## Glomangiomyoma

A benign glomus tumor showing both vascular and smooth-muscle differentiation, usually presenting as a small painful subcutaneous nodule.

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### **Glomangiosarcoma**

A rare malignant glomus tumor showing cytologic atypia, infiltrative growth, or other malignant features; complete excision and specialist evaluation are required.

### **Giant Cell Tumor Of Tendon Sheath**

A common benign localized tenosynovial tumor, usually presenting as a slow-growing firm nodule on a finger or hand; recurrence can occur after excision.

### **Gemistocytic Astrocytoma**

A former histologic variant of diffuse astrocytoma composed partly of gemistocytic astrocytes. The term is now used mainly descriptively because integrated molecular classification determines the modern tumor diagnosis and grade.

### **Gliomatosis Cerebri**

A diffuse infiltrative growth pattern of glioma involving multiple brain regions, rather than a separate tumor type in current classifications; it may cause progressive cognitive, motor, or seizure-related symptoms.

### **Giant Cell Tumor Of Bone**

A locally aggressive osteoclast-rich bone tumor, usually arising near the end of a long bone in skeletally mature adults. It may cause pain, swelling, cortical destruction, and occasional pulmonary metastases.

## H

### 21-Hydroxylase Deficiency

An inherited defect in CYP21A2 that reduces cortisol and aldosterone synthesis, increases 17-hydroxyprogesterone, and causes congenital adrenal hyperplasia with androgen excess.

### Hair Bulb

The enlarged base of a hair follicle where the hair shaft is produced.

### Hair Shaft

The portion of a hair that projects above the skin surface.

### Hammertoe

A deformity in which a toe bends downward at a middle joint.

### Harm Reduction Therapy

Treatment that aims to reduce health and social harms from addictive behavior, even when abstinence is not immediate.

#### Synonyms:

Harm reduction

### Hay Fever

Seasonal or persistent allergic rhinitis caused by inhaled allergens.

#### Synonyms:

Allergic rhinitis Rhinitis, Allergic Seasonal Allergy Seasonal Allergies (Hay Fever)

### HbA1C

Hemoglobin with glucose attached; its measurement estimates average blood glucose over the previous

two to three months.

#### Synonyms:

Glycosylated hemoglobin; hemoglobin A1c

### Heberden Nodes

Bony enlargements at the end joints of fingers, commonly associated with osteoarthritis.

#### Synonyms:

Heberden's nodes

### Helper T Cells

CD4-positive immune cells that coordinate responses by activating other immune cells.

#### Synonyms:

CD4 T cells

### HEPA Filter

A high-efficiency particulate air filter that removes a large proportion of airborne particles.

#### Synonyms:

High-efficiency particulate air filter

### Heparin

An anticoagulant that reduces formation and extension of blood clots.

### Hepatologist

Physician specializing in disorders of the liver, biliary system, and pancreas.

### High Blood Pressure

Persistently elevated pressure of blood against artery walls.

#### Synonyms:

Hypertension

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## HLA

Human leukocyte antigen, a cell-surface protein system involved in immune recognition and tissue compatibility.

### Synonyms:

Human leukocyte antigen

## Hormones

Chemical messengers released by glands or tissues that regulate processes throughout the body.

## Hot Flash

A sudden episode of heat, flushing, sweating, and sometimes palpitations, commonly occurring during menopause.

### Synonyms:

Hot flush

## HPA

The hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis, a hormone system central to the stress response.

### Synonyms:

Hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis

## Human Leukocyte Antigen

A protein on cell surfaces that helps the immune system distinguish self from foreign material.

### Synonyms:

HLA

## Humectant

A substance that attracts and retains water, commonly used to hydrate skin.

## Hyaluronic Acid

A naturally occurring carbohydrate polymer that binds water in connective tissue, skin, joints, and the eye.

### Synonyms:

Hyaluronan

## Hydrogenation

A chemical process that adds hydrogen to a compound; in foods it can convert liquid oils into more solid fats.

## Hydroxyapatite

A calcium-phosphate mineral forming much of the hardness of bones and teeth.

## Hygiene Hypothesis

The theory that limited early-life microbial exposure may increase susceptibility to allergies and immune disorders.

## Hyperalgesia

An abnormally increased response to a painful stimulus.

## Hyperinsulinemia

An abnormally high concentration of insulin in the blood.

## Hyperplastic Polyp

A usually benign overgrowth of mucosal cells, often found in the colon or rectum.

## Hypertensive Cerebellar Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the cerebellum caused by rupture of a vessel damaged by high blood pressure.

## Hypertensive Intracerebral Hemorrhage

Bleeding into brain tissue caused by rupture of a blood vessel associated with hypertension.

## Hypnagogic Hallucinations

Vivid sensory experiences occurring while a person is falling asleep.

## Hypnogram

A chart showing the timing and stages of sleep during a recording.

### Synonyms:

Sleep-stage diagram

## Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis

A network linking the hypothalamus, pituitary gland, and adrenal glands to regulate stress hormones and other functions.

### Synonyms:



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HPA axis

## **H Influenzae Meningitis**

Bacterial meningitis caused by *Haemophilus influenzae*, especially type b in unvaccinated children. It may cause fever, headache, neck stiffness, altered consciousness, seizures, and serious neurologic complications.

## **H1N1 Influenza**

Influenza A infection caused by an H1N1 virus strain. It usually produces fever, cough, sore throat, myalgia, and fatigue but can cause viral pneumonia and severe respiratory failure in high-risk patients.

## **Histamine-2 Receptor Antagonist**

A drug that blocks histamine H2 receptors on gastric parietal cells, reducing gastric acid secretion. Agents: cimetidine, ranitidine, famotidine, nizatidine. Used for GERD, peptic ulcer disease, and dyspepsia—less potent than PPIs. Adverse effects: headache, diarrhea, confusion (elderly, cimetidine), and rare thrombocytopenia.

## **Habenula**

A paired epithalamic structure forming part of the dorsal diencephalon. It integrates limbic and basal-forebrain signals with midbrain monoaminergic systems and contributes to reward, aversion, stress, and motivational behavior.

## **Haem- / Haema- / Haemato- / Haemo- (Prefixes Relating To Blood)**

Prefixes derived from the Greek word *haima* (blood), used in medical terminology to denote blood-related conditions and procedures.

### **Synonyms:**

Prefixes relating to blood

## **Haemangioma**

A benign vascular tumor composed of proliferating endothelial cells, the most common soft tissue tumor of infancy.

## **Haemarthrosis**

Bleeding into a joint cavity. Causes: trauma (most common), hemophilia (spontaneous haemarthrosis is characteristic, especially in severe deficiency of factor VIII or IX, common in knees, elbows, ankles), anticoagulant therapy, pigmented villonodular synovitis (PVNS, recurrent haemarthrosis), joint surgery, and vascular malformations.

## **Haematocrit**

The proportion of blood volume occupied by red blood cells, expressed as a percentage or decimal fraction. The reference range varies with age, sex, altitude, pregnancy, and laboratory method.

## **Haematologist**

A medical doctor who specializes in the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of diseases of the blood and blood-forming organs.

## **Haematoma**

A localised collection of blood outside blood vessels, usually clotted, within an organ or tissue. Haematomas form when trauma or disease causes a blood vessel to rupture.

## **Haematuria**

The presence of blood in the urine. Classification: gross (visible to the naked eye, indicates bleeding beyond the nephron) vs microscopic (detected only on urinalysis or microscopy, >3 RBCs per high-power field).

## **Haemodialysis**

A medical procedure that filters waste products, toxins, and excess fluid from the blood when the kidneys are unable to do so (end-stage renal disease, ESRD). Mechanism: blood is pumped through an extracorporeal circuit and passes through a dialyser (artificial kidney) containing thousands of hollow fibers with a semipermeable membrane.

## **Haemolytic Disease Of The Newborn**

Destruction of a newborn's red blood cells by maternal antibodies that crossed the placenta, causing anemia and jaundice.

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## Haemophilia

An X-linked recessive bleeding disorder caused by deficiency of coagulation factor VIII (hemophilia A, 80-85%) or factor IX (hemophilia B, Christmas disease, 15-20%). Incidence: 1 in 5,000 male births (hemophilia A), 1 in 30,000 (hemophilia B).

## Haemophilus Influenzae

A gram-negative coccobacillus that causes meningitis, epiglottitis, pneumonia, and other infections. The encapsulated type b (Hib) strain was the most virulent, causing invasive disease in children. The Hib conjugate vaccine has dramatically reduced the incidence of invasive Hib disease.

## Haemoptysis

Coughing up blood or blood-stained sputum from the lower respiratory tract.

## Haemorrhoids

Enlarged symptomatic vascular cushions of the anal canal that may cause painless bright-red rectal bleeding, prolapse, itching, or discomfort.

## Hair Cells

The sensory receptor cells of the inner ear that convert mechanical sound vibrations into electrical neural signals, and they are named for the bundle of stereocilia projecting from their apical surface.

## Hair Follicle

Complex dermal/hypodermal mini-organ producing hair. Has infundibulum (surface opening), isthmus (from sebaceous duct to arrector pili insertion), and lower segment (bulb with matrix and dermal papilla). Hair cycle: anagen (active growth, 2-7 years), catagen (regression, 2-3 weeks), telogen (resting, 2-3 months).

## Hair Loss

Alopecia: reduction of scalp or body hair. Types: nonscarring (androgenetic—pattern hair loss, telogen effluvium—stress/illness/drugs, anagen effluvium—chemotherapy, alopecia areata—autoimmune patches, tinea capitis, trichotillomania) and scarring (lupus, lichen

planopilaris, folliculitis decalvans). Female pattern hair loss is common.

### Synonyms:

Alopecia (Hair Loss)

## Hair Loss (Alopecia)

The partial or complete loss of hair from areas where it normally grows, most commonly the scalp. Causes include genetic predisposition (androgenetic alopecia), autoimmune conditions (alopecia areata), hormonal changes, medications, stress, and nutritional deficiencies.

### Synonyms:

Alopecia

## Hair Loss Classification

Hair loss (alopecia) is classified as scarring (cicatricial) or non-scarring. Non-scarring alopecias are potentially reversible: androgenetic alopecia (male and female pattern), alopecia areata, telogen effluvium, anagen effluvium, and tinea capitis.

## Hairy Cell Leukemia

A rare, indolent B-cell chronic lymphoproliferative disorder characterized by the accumulation of mature B lymphocytes with characteristic cytoplasmic projections ("hairy cells") in the bone marrow, peripheral blood, and spleen.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Hairy Cell Leukemia Leukemia, Hairy Cell

## Hairy Tongue

A usually harmless overgrowth and discoloration of the tongue's papillae, often appearing black, brown, or white. It may be associated with smoking, poor oral hygiene, dry mouth, or antibiotics; gentle tongue cleaning and removal of contributing factors usually help.

## Haldane Effect

The decrease in hemoglobin's CO<sub>2</sub> carrying capacity when oxygen binds to it, facilitating CO<sub>2</sub> release at the lungs. Deoxygenated hemoglobin (deoxyhemoglobin) is a better buffer for H<sup>+</sup> ions and forms more carbaminohemoglobin than oxyhemoglobin.

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## Half-Life

Elimination half-life is the time required for the plasma concentration of a drug to decrease by 50 percent after reaching equilibrium. It is calculated from the elimination rate constant using the equation  $t_{1/2}$  equals 0.693 divided by the elimination rate constant.

## Half-Life (Physical)

Time for radioactive isotope to decay to half its original activity. F-18: 110 min; Tc-99m: 6 hours; I-131: 8 days; Ga-68: 68 min. Affects imaging timing, radiation dose.

### Synonyms:

Physical

## Half-Life ( $T_{1/2}$ )

The time required for plasma drug concentration to decrease by 50%. It determines dosing frequency and time to steady state (4-5 half-lives). Drugs with long half-lives (e.g., amiodarone: 40-55 days, warfarin: 40 hours) can be given once daily but take longer to reach steady state and to be eliminated.

### Synonyms:

$t_{1/2}$

## Halitosis

An unpleasant odour of the breath that may be socially distressing. The most common cause (85-90%) is poor oral hygiene—accumulation of bacteria on the tongue, dental plaque, periodontitis, and gingivitis.

## Hallucination

A perception in the absence of an external stimulus, experienced as real and occurring in objective space.

## Hallux Valgus

Lateral deviation of the great toe (hallux) with medial prominence of the first metatarsal head (bunion). More common in women, associated with narrow-toed shoes, high heels, and genetic predisposition. Presents with pain over the medial eminence, difficulty with shoe wear, and progressive deformity.

## Hallux Valgus (Bunion)

A progressive deformity of the first metatarsophalangeal (MTP) joint, characterized by lateral deviation of the great toe (hallux valgus) and medial deviation of the first metatarsal head (metatarsus primus varus), resulting in a bony prominence on the medial side of the forefoot (the bunion).

### Synonyms:

Bunion

## Halo Nevus

A benign melanocytic nevus surrounded by a rim of depigmentation (Sutton nevus), caused by an immune-mediated T-cell response directed against melanocytes in the nevus. It is most common on the trunk of children and young adults and typically resolves by central depigmentation, leaving a white macule.

## Hamartoma

A benign growth composed of a disorganized mixture of tissue elements normally present at that site, e.g., pulmonary hamartoma, Peutz-Jeghers polyps, and PTEN-related (Cowden) lesions.

## Hamate

Wedge-shaped distal row carpal bone on the ulnar side with the hook of the hamate. The hook forms Guyon's canal medial border and serves as flexor retinaculum attachment. Articulates with 4th/5th metacarpals. Hook fractures associated with racquet sports and ulnar nerve compression.

## Hamman's Sign

A crunching or crackling sound heard on auscultation synchronized with the heartbeat, caused by air in the mediastinum (pneumomediastinum). It is a rare but specific finding. It is also described as a mediastinal crunch heard in spontaneous pneumomediastinum.

## Hammer

The common name for the malleus, one of the three small bones of the middle ear.

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## Hammer Toe

A deformity of the second, third, or fourth toe characterized by flexion at the PIP joint and extension at the MTP and DIP joints. Caused by muscle imbalance (intrinsic foot muscle weakness) and narrow-toed shoes. Presents with pain over the dorsal PIP joint (corn/callus) and the tip of the toe. Flexible hammer toe: correctable passively.

## Hampton Hump

Wedge-shaped opacification with its base abutting the pleura on chest radiography, representing pulmonary infarction secondary to Pulmonary Embolism. See Pulmonary Embolism (PE).

## Hampton's Hump

Wedge-shaped, pleural-based opacity on CXR representing pulmonary infarction distal to PE.

## Hamstring

One of three muscles forming the posterior compartment of the thigh: semitendinosus, semimembranosus, and biceps femoris (long and short heads). Common origin: ischial tuberosity (except short head of biceps femoris which originates from the linea aspera of the femur).

## Hamstring Muscles

Three posterior thigh muscles: biceps femoris (long/short heads), semitendinosus, semimembranosus, mostly from the ischial tuberosity (short head of biceps from linea aspera). Long head/semimembranosus/semitendinosus innervated by tibial sciatic nerve; short head by common peroneal division. Flex knee, extend hip.

## Hand Foot And Mouth Disease

A common viral illness (mostly children <10 years) caused by coxsackievirus A16 (and enterovirus 71), transmitted by fecal-oral/respiratory.

## Hand Hygiene

The most effective measure for preventing healthcare-associated infections. Hand hygiene includes handwashing with soap and water and hand rubbing with alcohol-based rubs. Alcohol-based

rubs are preferred for routine hand hygiene as they are faster and more effective than soap and water.

## Hand Prolapse

Prolapse of a fetal hand or arm alongside or below the presenting part. May occur spontaneously or after manual rotation. The prolapsed arm may be mistaken for a cord or foot. Management: if the hand is above the presenting part (compound presentation), it may be gently pushed back during contractions.

## Hand, Foot, And Mouth Disease

A contagious viral illness, usually in children, causing fever and vesicles or ulcers on the hands, feet, and mouth. Enteroviruses are common causes.

## Hand-Foot-And-Mouth Syndrome

A usually mild, contagious viral illness, commonly caused by enteroviruses, producing fever, mouth sores, and small spots or blisters on the hands and feet. It mainly affects young children but can occur in adults. Hydration, pain relief, and hygiene are important; severe dehydration, neurologic symptoms, or persistent fever requires care.

## Hand-Foot-Mouth Disease

A common enteroviral infection, usually in young children, causing fever, painful oral ulcers, and a vesicular rash on the hands, feet, and sometimes buttocks. It is highly contagious and usually self-limited.

## Hanging (Complete Vs Incomplete)

Form of violent asphyxial death produced by suspension of the body by a ligature around the neck. Complete Hanging: feet off ground, total body weight exerts pressure. Incomplete Hanging: part of body touches ground. Asphyxia results from occlusion of jugular veins (2 kg force) or carotid arteries (5 kg force).

### Synonyms:

Complete vs Incomplete

## Hanging And Strangulation Signs

Medico-legal findings resulting from mechanical con-

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striction of the neck structures. Hanging: neck constriction by a ligature tightened by the weight of the victim's body. Ligature mark: pale, hard, parchment-like groove running obliquely upward toward the knot, usually situated above the thyroid cartilage.

### **Hansen's Disease (Leprosy)**

A chronic infection caused mainly by *Mycobacterium leprae* that primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves. It can cause numb skin patches, nerve thickening, weakness, and eye problems. Transmission usually requires prolonged close contact, and multidrug therapy can cure the infection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Leprosy

### **Hantavirus**

Hantavirus infection is acquired from exposure to infected rodent excreta and can cause hemorrhagic fever with renal syndrome or severe cardiopulmonary syndrome. to humans primarily through inhalation of aerosolized rodent excreta (urine, feces, saliva).

### **Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome**

A severe respiratory illness caused by hantaviruses, usually acquired by inhaling aerosolized particles from infected rodent urine, droppings, or nesting material. Fever, muscle aches, headache, and gastrointestinal symptoms may rapidly progress to cough, pulmonary edema, and respiratory failure. Immediate hospital care is essential.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sin Nombre Virus Infection

### **Haplotype**

Set of alleles inherited together on same chromosome. Used in linkage analysis, population genetics, disease association studies.

### **Haptoglobin**

An alpha-2 globulin that binds free hemoglobin, preventing oxidative damage and renal excretion. Low/undetectable: acute hemolysis (intravascular and extravascular), liver disease (decreased

production), and hereditary deficiency. Elevated: acute phase reaction (inflammation, infection, malignancy).

### **Harlequin Color Change**

A transient, benign skin color change in newborns where one half of the body becomes flushed while the other half remains pale, due to asymmetric vasomotor tone. It occurs in up to 10 percent of healthy neonates, typically when the infant is placed on their side.

### **Harm Reduction**

Evidence-based strategies that decrease health, social, and legal harms associated with substance use without requiring immediate abstinence. Examples include naloxone access, sterile injecting equipment, drug-checking where available, safer-use education, and linkage to treatment.

### **Hartmann Procedure**

Surgical resection of the rectosigmoid colon with creation of an end colostomy and rectal stump. Used for emergency resection of complicated diverticulitis with peritonitis and colorectal cancer with obstruction or perforation. The procedure avoids primary anastomosis in a contaminated field.

### **Hartnup Disease**

An autosomal-recessive disorder of neutral-amino acid transport, especially in the intestine and renal tubules. Defective tryptophan handling can cause pellagra-like photosensitive dermatitis, cerebellar ataxia, and neuropsychiatric symptoms, often intermittently.

### **Hashimoto Thyroiditis**

An autoimmune disorder in which immune-mediated inflammation gradually damages the thyroid gland and may cause hypothyroidism. The gland may be enlarged or atrophic, and thyroid autoantibodies are often present.

### **Hay Fever (Allergic Rhinitis)**

Inflammation of the nasal lining caused by an allergic response to airborne substances, including



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pollens, dust mites, animal dander, or mold. It causes sneezing, congestion, nasal itching, and watery discharge.

**Synonyms:**

Allergic Rhinitis

**HbA1C (Glycated Hemoglobin)**

Hemoglobin containing glucose-derived adducts formed by nonenzymatic glycation. It reflects average glycemic exposure over approximately two to three months, with interpretation affected by altered red-cell survival and some hemoglobin variants.

**Synonyms:**

Glycated Hemoglobin

**HCG (Human Chorionic Gonadotropin)**

A hormone produced mainly by placental tissue and measured in urine or blood to help detect and monitor pregnancy. Concentrations normally rise early in pregnancy, but the rate and interpretation vary; results must be considered with timing and clinical findings.

**Synonyms:**

Human Chorionic Gonadotropin

**HDL**

High-density lipoprotein, a class of particles that transports cholesterol and other lipids in the blood. HDL concentration is one component of cardiovascular risk assessment; it should not be interpreted as a protective or harmful measure by itself.

**Head And Neck Cancer**

Cancers arising in the oral cavity, pharynx, larynx, sinonasal tract, and salivary glands, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma. Risk factors include tobacco, alcohol, and HPV (oropharyngeal). Treatment involves surgery, radiation, and chemotherapy, often combined to preserve function.

**Head Circumference**

Measured at the largest circumference above the ears and eyebrows, reflecting brain growth. Plotted on growth charts to detect microcephaly (below 3rd percentile) or macrocephaly (above 98th percentile). Rapid increase may indicate hydrocephalus or in-

tracranial hemorrhage; failure to grow may indicate microcephaly or brain atrophy.

**Head Injury**

Trauma to scalp, skull, or brain. Scalp lacerations: bleed profusely, require suturing. Skull fracture: basilar (Battle sign, raccoon eyes) or depressed (surgical emergency). Concussion: transient neurological dysfunction, manage with rest, gradual return to activity.

**Synonyms:**

Brain Injury (Head Injury)

**Headache**

Headache is pain in the head or upper neck; onset, pattern, associated neurologic findings, fever, trauma, and systemic symptoms distinguish primary from secondary causes. tension-type, cluster, and trigeminal autonomic cephalalgias) or secondary (attributed to an underlying structural, infectious, vascular, or metabolic cause).

**Headache And Migraine**

Headaches are pain in the head or upper neck region, classified as primary (tension-type, migraine, cluster) or secondary to underlying conditions. Migraines are a neurological disorder characterized by recurrent episodes of moderate to severe throbbing pain, often accompanied by nausea, photophobia, and aura.

**Health Behavior**

An action or pattern of action that affects health, such as eating, physical activity, tobacco use, alcohol use, sexual practices, or taking medicines.

**Health Behavior Change**

Modification of behaviors that affect health, such as tobacco use, diet, physical activity, and adherence to treatment.

**Health Behavior Motivation**

Factors that influence initiation and maintenance of health-related behaviors, including adherence, physical activity, and smoking cessation.



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## Health Disparities

Differences in health outcomes or access to care among groups, often associated with social, economic, environmental, geographic, or structural factors.

## Health Disparity

Difference in health outcomes between populations. Examples: racial disparities, socioeconomic disparities, geographic disparities.

## Health Equity

The fair opportunity for all people to attain their highest possible level of health, without avoidable differences caused by social or economic disadvantage.

## Health Inequity

A systematic, avoidable, and unjust difference in health or access to health resources between social groups. It differs from health variation that is not preventable or not linked to unfair social conditions.

## Health Information Technology

Use of technology for health information. Examples: electronic health records, telemedicine, mobile health, decision support.

## Health Literacy

Ability to obtain, process, understand health information. Examples: reading labels, following instructions, communicating with providers.

## Health Promotion

Activities maintaining/improving health in elderly. Components: vaccination, screening, exercise, nutrition, cognitive stimulation, social engagement, fall prevention. Tailored to individual capacity and preferences.

## Health Surveillance

The ongoing collection and analysis of health data to identify patterns, monitor disease, and guide public-health action.

## Health-Related QoL

A person's perceived physical, psychological, and social well-being as affected by health and illness.

## Healthcare Associated Infection

An infection developing as a consequence of health-care delivery, typically beyond 48 hours after admission or within 30 days of a procedure.

## Healthcare Provider

A healthcare professional or organization that provides medical care, such as a physician, nurse, therapist, or clinic.

## Healthcare Proxy

A person designated to make healthcare decisions for someone who cannot make or communicate those decisions. The appointment may be recorded in an advance directive or other legal document.

## Healthcare-Associated Pneumonia

HCAP concept retired (2016 IDSA/ATS); risk factors for MDR now assessed individually. Risk factors for MDR pathogens (prior antibiotics, structural lung disease, frequent hospitalization) should be assessed individually rather than using the HCAP category.

## Healthy Aging

The process of developing and maintaining the functional ability that supports well-being in older age.

## Healthy Eating For Diabetes

A dietary approach designed to maintain stable blood glucose levels in individuals with diabetes mellitus. It emphasizes carbohydrate consistency, high fiber intake, lean proteins, and healthy fats while minimizing refined sugars and simple carbohydrates.

## Healthy Years

Years of life lived in good health, without substantial disease, disability, or loss of function.

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## Healthy Years Lost

Years of life lost due to premature death or disability. DALYs combine YLL and YLD.

## Hearing Aid

Amplification device for hearing loss. Types: behind-the-ear (BTE), in-the-ear (ITE), receiver-in-canal (RIC). Components: microphone, amplifier, speaker, battery. Fitting: audiogram-based. Adjustments: volume, programs.

## Hearing Aids And Devices

Electronic devices worn in or behind the ear that amplify sound for individuals with hearing loss. Modern hearing aids include digital signal processing, directional microphones, and connectivity to smartphones and other audio sources.

## Hearing Impairment

Partial or complete reduction in the ability to detect or understand sound. It may be conductive, sensorineural, or mixed and can result from congenital disorders, infection, noise, ototoxic injury, trauma, ageing, or disease of the ear or auditory pathways.

## Hearing Loss

Reduced ability to hear, classified as conductive (outer/middle ear pathology: cerumen impaction, otitis media, otosclerosis, tympanic membrane perforation), sensorineural (inner ear or auditory nerve: presbycusis, noise exposure, ototoxic drugs, Meniere disease, acoustic neuroma), or mixed.

### Synonyms:

Noise-Related Hearing Loss

## Hearing Loss: Sudden Deafness

A rapid sensorineural hearing loss, usually developing over hours to a few days, that may affect one or both ears. It is an otologic emergency; urgent hearing testing and evaluation are needed because early treatment may improve recovery.

## Hearing Screening

Newborn hearing screening (universal): otoacoustic emissions (OAE) and/or automated auditory brain-

stem response (AABR) before discharge; referral for comprehensive audiology if failed.

## Heart

A four-chambered muscular pump (two atria, two ventricles) located in the mediastinum, responsible for circulating blood throughout the body.

## Heart Attack

Acute myocardial injury caused most often by blockage of a coronary artery, usually from rupture of an atherosclerotic plaque and thrombosis. It may cause chest pressure, shortness of breath, sweating, nausea, or atypical symptoms and requires emergency treatment.

### Synonyms:

Myocardial Infarction (Heart Attack)

## Heart Attack (Myocardial Infarction)

The death of heart muscle tissue due to sudden blockage of a coronary artery, typically by a blood clot. It presents with chest pain or pressure, shortness of breath, nausea, and diaphoresis, though symptoms may be atypical in women and diabetics.

### Synonyms:

Myocardial Infarction

## Heart Block

A delay or interruption in the conduction of cardiac impulses from the atria to the ventricles through the atrioventricular (AV) node and His-Purkinje system. Classification: first-degree AV block: PR interval >200 ms, each atrial impulse conducts to the ventricles, typically asymptomatic.

## Heart Disease

A broad term encompassing various conditions affecting the heart and blood vessels, most commonly coronary artery disease, heart failure, arrhythmias, and valvular heart disease. Atherosclerosis, the buildup of plaque in the arteries, is the underlying cause of most cardiovascular events.

## Heart Failure

A clinical syndrome in which symptoms or signs

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result from impaired cardiac structure or function. It may be classified by ejection fraction, including reduced, mildly reduced, or preserved function, and by symptom severity such as NYHA class I-IV.

### Heart Failure Stages

ACC/AHA staging: Stage A (at risk for HF but no structural disease or symptoms); Stage B (structural heart disease but no symptoms); Stage C (structural disease with prior or current symptoms); Stage D (advanced HF requiring specialized interventions). This staging system emphasizes prevention and progression.

### Heart Failure With Preserved Ejection Fraction

A clinical syndrome of heart failure with a relatively preserved left-ventricular ejection fraction, often associated with impaired relaxation or increased stiffness. Diagnosis requires compatible symptoms or signs and objective evidence of cardiac dysfunction or elevated filling pressures.

### Heart Failure With Reduced Ejection Fraction

A clinical syndrome of heart failure with reduced left-ventricular systolic function, commonly associated with ischemic heart disease, cardiomyopathy, hypertension, or valvular disease. The ejection-fraction threshold is defined by the applicable guideline and should be interpreted with the clinical findings.

### Heart Health

The state of cardiovascular well-being, characterized by efficient pumping function, clear arteries, normal blood pressure, and regular heart rhythm. Maintaining heart health involves a heart-healthy diet, regular aerobic and resistance exercise, weight management, stress reduction, and avoidance of tobacco.

### Heart Murmur

An audible extra sound produced by turbulent blood flow within the heart or great vessels, heard on auscultation.

**Synonyms:**

Murmur Congenital (Heart Murmur) Murmur Heart (Heart Murmur)

### Heart Palpitations

An awareness of the heartbeat as pounding, racing, fluttering, or irregular. Palpitations may occur with normal rhythm or arrhythmia and can be triggered by stress, exertion, fever, stimulants, endocrine disease, or structural heart disease.

**Synonyms:**

Skipped Heartbeats

### Heart Rate

The number of cardiac contractions (heartbeats) per minute. Normal resting heart rate (sinus rhythm): 60-100 bpm in adults; higher in children (70-120 at age 1-2 years, 80-130 in neonates).

### Heart Sounds

Audible sounds produced by the heart during the cardiac cycle, normally heard as two sounds (lub-dub). S1 (lub) is caused by closure of the mitral and tricuspid valves at the beginning of systole. S2 (dub) is caused by closure of the aortic and pulmonary valves at the end of systole. Additional sounds (S3, S4) may indicate pathology.

### Heart Surgery

Surgical procedures performed on the heart or great vessels to treat structural or functional cardiac conditions. Common operations include coronary artery bypass grafting (CABG), valve repair or replacement, and repair of congenital heart defects.

### Heart Valve

A flap-like structure that directs one-way blood flow through the heart. The four valves are the tricuspid, pulmonary, mitral, and aortic valves.

### Heart Valve Disorders

Disorders affecting any of the four heart valves, including stenosis (narrowing) and regurgitation (leaking), which impair blood flow through the heart. Causes include congenital malformations, age-related degeneration, rheumatic fever, and endocarditis.

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## Heart Valve Prosthesis

Replacement heart valve. Types: mechanical (titanium, carbon, durable, requires lifelong anticoagulation), bioprosthetic (cow/pig tissue, no anticoagulation, degenerates). Mechanical: more durable, higher thrombotic risk. Bioprosthetic: better quality of life, reoperation risk.

## Heart Ventricles

The two lower chambers of the heart. The right ventricle pumps blood to the lungs, and the left ventricle pumps blood to the body.

## Heart-Healthy Eating

A dietary approach emphasizing foods that support cardiovascular function and reduce the risk of heart disease. Key principles include limiting saturated fats, trans fats, sodium, and added sugars while prioritizing fruits, vegetables, whole grains, lean proteins, and healthy fats like those from olive oil and fatty fish.

## Heartburn

Heartburn is a burning retrosternal sensation caused by reflux of gastric contents; frequent or complicated symptoms may indicate gastroesophageal reflux disease. the throat and is often associated with regurgitation of sour or bitter-tasting fluid into the mouth. Despite its name, heartburn is a symptom of gastro-oesophageal reflux disease (GORD), not a cardiac symptom.

## Heat Cramps

Painful, involuntary muscle spasms occurring during or after strenuous activity in heat, often related to fluid and electrolyte loss. Resting in a cool place and replacing fluids and electrolytes may help. Confusion, fainting, or ongoing symptoms may signal heat illness requiring urgent medical attention.

### Synonyms:

Cramps Heat (Heat Cramps)

## Heat Exhaustion

A heat-related illness caused by excessive loss of water and salt, producing weakness, dizziness, nausea, headache, sweating, and sometimes fainting without

severe central nervous system dysfunction.

### Synonyms:

Exhaustion Heat (Heat Exhaustion)

## Heat Intolerance

An abnormal inability to tolerate warm environments or increased body heat, often causing excessive sweating, flushing, fatigue, or dizziness. Common causes include hyperthyroidism, menopause, fever, medications, autonomic disorders, and dehydration.

## Heat Pack

A device that applies warmth to the body surface to relieve some muscle pain or stiffness. Excessive heat or prolonged contact can cause burns.

## Heat Rash

An itchy or prickly rash caused by blocked sweat ducts during hot, humid conditions. Small red bumps or clear vesicles often appear in skin folds or areas covered by clothing. Cooling, keeping the skin dry, and avoiding occlusive products usually help; infection or persistent symptoms warrants assessment.

### Synonyms:

Profunda Miliaria (Heat Rash) Rash Heat (Heat Rash) Ruba Miliaria (Heat Rash)

## Heat Stroke

A life-threatening heat-related illness with markedly elevated body temperature and altered mental status. It requires immediate cooling and emergency medical treatment.

### Synonyms:

Stroke Heat (Heat Stroke)

## Heavy Metal Poisoning

Lead, mercury, arsenic, cadmium, thallium. Chelation therapy, supportive care, prevention. Sources: paint, water pipes, fish, occupational exposure.

## Heberden Node

A firm bony enlargement of the distal interphalangeal joint, usually caused by hand osteoarthritis.

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It may be tender during progression and can produce deformity, reduced fine-motor function, or restricted finger movement.

### **Heel Pain**

Pain beneath or around the heel, commonly caused by plantar fasciitis, Achilles tendinopathy, bursitis, stress fracture, nerve compression, or inflammatory arthritis. Persistent pain, swelling, inability to bear weight, or trauma requires assessment.

### **Heel Spur**

A bony growth arising from the heel bone, often associated with plantar-fascia strain. The spur itself may cause no symptoms; heel pain is more often related to surrounding soft-tissue inflammation.

### **Heimlich Manoeuvre**

An emergency procedure for relieving upper airway obstruction caused by a foreign body (choking). The maneuver is performed on a conscious, choking adult who cannot speak, cough effectively, or breathe.

### **Heinz Bodies**

Clumps of denatured hemoglobin inside red blood cells caused by oxidative injury. They may occur in glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency after exposure to oxidizing substances and are identified with special stains.

### **Helicobacter Pylori**

A gram-negative, spiral-shaped bacterium adapted to colonize the stomach. It can cause chronic gastritis, peptic ulcer disease, and increase the risk of gastric cancer and gastric MALT lymphoma.

### **Helicobacter Pylori Infection**

Infection of the stomach by *H. pylori*, a spiral-shaped bacterium associated with chronic gastritis, peptic ulcer disease, gastric adenocarcinoma, and gastric MALT lymphoma. It is diagnosed with noninvasive or endoscopic testing and treated with combination eradication therapy.

### **HELLP Syndrome**

A serious pregnancy-associated disorder characterized by hemolysis, elevated liver enzymes, and low platelet count. It may occur with or without classic hypertension or proteinuria and requires urgent assessment.

### **Helminths**

Parasitic worms that cause disease in humans. The major groups are nematodes (roundworms), cestodes (tapeworms), and trematodes (flukes). Helminths have complex life cycles often involving intermediate hosts. Infection occurs through ingestion of eggs or larvae, penetration of skin, or insect vectors.

### **Helper T Cell**

A type of CD4-positive T lymphocyte that coordinates immune responses by releasing cytokines and activating other immune cells.

### **HELPERR Mnemonic**

A mnemonic for the sequential management of shoulder dystocia: H — Help (call for additional personnel, anesthesia, and pediatrics). E — Evaluate for episiotomy (generous episiotomy to provide more room). L — Legs (McRoberts maneuver: hyperflex maternal legs onto the abdomen).

### **Hemangioblastoma**

A benign, well-circumscribed vascular tumor of the central nervous system, most commonly the cerebellum, often cystic with a mural nodule. Associated with von Hippel-Lindau disease; treated by surgical resection.

### **Hemangioma**

A benign tumor of blood vessel endothelial cells, common in infants. Most involute spontaneously; treatment includes laser therapy or surgery for problematic lesions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Infantile Hemangioma Strawberry Hemangioma

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## Hemangiosarcoma

A malignant tumor of vascular endothelial cells, an aggressive sarcoma that may arise in the skin, liver, or bone.

## Hematemesis

Vomiting of blood, indicating upper gastrointestinal bleeding proximal to the ligament of Treitz. Blood may be bright red (acute, brisk bleeding) or resemble coffee grounds (altered blood that has been in contact with gastric acid).

## Hematochezia

The passage of bright red or maroon blood per rectum, usually indicating active lower gastrointestinal (LGI) bleeding distal to the ligament of Treitz (e.g., diverticulosis, arteriovenous malformations/angiodysplasia, colorectal polyps/cancer, inflammatory bowel disease, hemorrhoids).

## Hematocrit

The proportion of blood volume occupied by packed red blood cells, expressed as a percentage. One of the most commonly ordered laboratory tests in clinical medicine.

## Hematologic Changes In Pregnancy

Plasma volume increases 40-50% while red cell mass increases 20-30%, resulting in physiologic anemia (Hb 10-11 g/dL). Leukocytosis (WBC up to 15,000-16,000/ $\mu$ L, predominantly neutrophils) is normal.

## Hematology

The branch of medicine concerned with the study, diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of disorders of the blood and blood-forming organs (bone marrow, lymph nodes, spleen).

## Hematometocolpos

Accumulation of blood in the uterine cavity and vagina due to outflow obstruction such as an imperforate hymen or transverse vaginal septum, presenting with cyclic pelvic pain and primary amenorrhea in adolescents.

## Hematopoiesis

The production and maturation of blood cells from multipotent hematopoietic stem cells, principally in the bone marrow after birth. It generates erythrocytes, leukocytes, and platelets through regulated progenitor-cell differentiation.

## Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation

Infusion of hematopoietic stem cells after a conditioning regimen to restore marrow function or replace diseased hematopoiesis. Autologous HSCT uses the patient's own cells; allogeneic HSCT uses cells from a donor and carries risks including graft-versus-host disease and graft failure.

## Hematuria

Presence of red blood cells in the urine, categorized as microscopic ( $>3$  RBCs per high-power field on urine microscopy) or gross (macroscopic, visible color change from pink to dark red). Microscopic hematuria is often asymptomatic and detected on routine urinalysis.

## Hemianopia

Loss of vision in half the visual field of one or both eyes. Homonymous hemianopia affects the same side in both eyes and localizes to a contralateral lesion posterior to the optic chiasm, most often stroke or tumor.

## Hemicolecotomy

Surgical removal of the right or left portion of the colon, sometimes with nearby lymph nodes and reconnection of the bowel.

## Hemifacial Microsomia

A congenital craniofacial disorder involving asymmetric hypoplasia of the structures derived from the first and second branchial arches, most commonly affecting the mandible, ear, and soft tissues on one side. Also known as craniofacial microsomia or Goldenhar syndrome when epibulbar dermoids and vertebral anomalies are present.

### Synonyms:

craniofacial microsomia or.



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## Hemifacial Spasm

Involuntary, unilateral, intermittent twitching of the facial muscles innervated by the facial nerve (CN VII). Typically begins around the eye (orbicularis oculi) and spreads to the lower face.

## Hemiparesis

Weakness affecting one side of the body, less severe than hemiplegia (paralysis). It results from a lesion of the corticospinal tract anywhere from the motor cortex to the spinal cord, most commonly from stroke, but also from tumors, trauma, or demyelination. The pattern of weakness helps localize the lesion.

## Hemiplegia

Paralysis of one side of the body (the face, arm, and leg on the same side), caused by damage to the corticospinal tract (pyramidal tract) at any level from the cerebral cortex to the spinal cord.

## Hemochromatosis

Hemochromatosis is excessive iron accumulation that can injure the liver, pancreas, heart, joints, skin, and endocrine organs; inherited and acquired forms exist. progressive iron deposition in parenchymal organs. Hereditary hemochromatosis is most commonly caused by homozygous C282Y mutations in the HFE gene affecting approximately one in two hundred individuals of Northern European descent.

## Hemochromatosis Cardiomyopathy

Iron overload cardiomyopathy from hereditary (HFE gene mutations, most common) or secondary causes. Iron deposition in the myocardium causes restrictive then dilated cardiomyopathy. Diagnosis: elevated transferrin saturation (>45%), ferritin, and genetic testing. Cardiac MRI T2\* <20 ms indicates myocardial iron overload.

## Hemodialysis

Extracorporeal blood purification using semipermeable membrane. Three sessions per week for 3 to 4 hours. Requires vascular access with AV fistula preferred. Adequacy assessed by Kt/V greater than 1.4. Complications include hypotension, access infection,

and dialyzer reactions.

## Hemofiltration

An extracorporeal process that removes plasma water and dissolved solutes by convection across a semipermeable membrane, with replacement fluid used to maintain volume. It is used in continuous and intermittent kidney-replacement modalities.

## Hemoglobin

Hemoglobin is the iron-containing protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen and carbon dioxide; its concentration and structure help evaluate anemia and hemoglobin disorders. heme groups that bind oxygen. Each heme contains iron (Fe<sup>2+</sup>) that reversibly binds O<sub>2</sub>. Cooperative binding produces sigmoidal oxygen dissociation curve. P50 (pO<sub>2</sub> at 50% saturation) 27 mmHg.

## Hemoglobin A1C

Glycated hemoglobin reflecting average blood glucose concentration over the preceding two to three months corresponding to the red blood cell lifespan. Formed by non-enzymatic glycation of hemoglobin at the N-terminal valine of the beta chain. The percent of glycated hemoglobin is directly proportional to mean glucose levels.

## Hemoglobin A1C Variability

Factors that can make hemoglobin A1c less reliable include altered red-cell survival, hemoglobin variants, anemia, pregnancy, kidney disease, transfusion, and some treatments. An alternative measure of glucose may be needed when A1c does not reflect recent glycemia.

## Hemoglobin C Disease

An inherited hemoglobinopathy caused by a beta-globin variant that produces hemoglobin C. It may cause mild hemolytic anemia, jaundice, splenomegaly, or, when combined with hemoglobin S, clinically significant sickling disease.

## Hemoglobin Electrophoresis

Separation of hemoglobin variants by electrophoresis or HPLC. Normal adult: HbA (95-98%), HbA<sub>2</sub> (2-

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3%), HbF (<1%). Sickle cell disease (HbSS): HbS only, no HbA. Sickle cell trait (HbAS): HbA > HbS. Thalassemia: elevated HbA2 or HbF.

### **Hemoglobinopathies: Thalassemias**

Thalassemias are inherited disorders of globin chain synthesis imbalance: alpha-thalassemia (HBA1/HBA2 deletions) and beta-thalassemia (HBB mutations).

### **Hemoglobinopathy**

A group of inherited disorders of hemoglobin structure or synthesis. Major types include sickle-cell disease and thalassemia; manifestations range from asymptomatic microcytosis to haemolytic anaemia, vaso-occlusion, and organ injury.

### **Hemolysis**

The premature destruction of red blood cells, releasing hemoglobin into the plasma. Extravascular hemolysis (most common): RBCs are destroyed by macrophages in the spleen and liver — causes unconjugated hyperbilirubinemia, increased LDH, and decreased haptoglobin.

### **Hemolytic Anemia**

Anemia due to accelerated destruction of red blood cells (RBCs), classified as intrinsic (RBC defect) or extrinsic (external factors). Intrinsic: hereditary spherocytosis, G6PD deficiency, sickle cell disease, thalassemia.

### **Hemolytic Anemias: Autoimmune**

Autoimmune hemolytic anemia occurs when antibodies or complement cause premature destruction of red blood cells. Warm-antibody and cold-antibody forms differ in their triggers, laboratory findings, and sites of red-cell destruction.

### **Hemolytic Anemias: Hereditary**

Hereditary spherocytosis (HS): cytoskeletal protein defects (ankyrin, band 3, protein 4.2, alpha/beta spectrin) -> spherical RBCs, splenic trapping, hemolysis. AD (75%) or AR. Clinical: anemia, jaundice, splenomegaly, gallstones.

### **Hemolytic Disease Of The Newborn**

A condition in which maternal antibodies destroy fetal/neonatal red blood cells (RBCs), causing hemolytic anemia, hyperbilirubinaemia, and in severe cases hydrops fetalis.

### **Hemolytic Jaundice**

Jaundice resulting from excessive hemolysis (breakdown of red blood cells) causing overproduction of unconjugated bilirubin that exceeds the liver's capacity for conjugation and excretion. See Jaundice for complete overview.

### **Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome**

A thrombotic microangiopathy characterized by red-cell destruction, low platelets, and acute kidney injury. It may follow Shiga-toxin-producing gastrointestinal infection or result from complement dysregulation and other causes.

### **Hemolytic-Uremic Syndrome**

A potentially life-threatening disorder characterized by microangiopathic hemolytic anemia, thrombocytopenia, and acute kidney injury. It often follows Shiga-toxin-producing bacterial gastroenteritis but may also result from complement dysregulation or other triggers.

### **Hemoperfusion**

Blood passed through adsorbent column (charcoal, resin) to remove toxins. Used for drug overdoses with high protein binding, large volume of distribution.

### **Hemophagocytic Lymphohistiocytosis**

HLH: uncontrolled immune activation with cytokine storm (IFN-gamma, IL-6, IL-10, TNF). Familial HLH (FHL): PRF1 (FHL2), UNC13D (FHL3), STX11 (FHL4), STXBP2 (FHL5), RAB27A (FHL6/GrisCELLI type 2). Secondary HLH: infections (EBV, CMV), malignancy (lymphoma), autoimmune (SJIA/MAS, SLE), immunodeficiency.

### **Hemophagocytosis Of Sickle Cells**

Activation of macrophages that engulf erythrocytes, leukocytes, and platelets within the bone marrow,

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occurring as a complication of sickle cell disease during severe hemolytic crises or infection.

### **Hemophilia**

Hemophilia is an inherited coagulation-factor deficiency, usually factor VIII or IX, causing prolonged bleeding into joints, muscles, and tissues after injury or spontaneously. VIII, IX, or another coagulation component. It causes prolonged bleeding, particularly into joints and muscles, after injury or procedures.

#### **Synonyms:**

A Hemophilia (Hemophilia) B Hemophilia (Hemophilia)

### **Hemophilia A**

An X-linked recessive deficiency of coagulation factor VIII, causing prolonged bleeding into joints, muscles, and soft tissues. Severity correlates with factor VIII activity levels.

### **Hemophilia B**

An X-linked recessive deficiency of coagulation factor IX (Christmas disease), causing prolonged bleeding similar to hemophilia A. Severity correlates with factor IX activity levels.

### **Hemoptysis**

Expectoration of blood from the lower respiratory tract. Must be differentiated from hematemesis and epistaxis. Causes: bronchitis, pneumonia, TB, bronchiectasis, lung cancer, PE.

### **Hemorrhage**

Abnormal escape of blood from a damaged blood vessel or, less commonly, from the heart. It may be external or internal, acute or chronic, and range from minor bleeding to life-threatening blood loss causing anemia, shock, or organ compression; the cause and site determine management.

### **Hemorrhagic**

Pertaining to or characterized by hemorrhage (extravasation of blood from vessels). Used in contexts such as hemorrhagic stroke, hemorrhagic shock, and hemorrhagic fever.

### **Hemorrhagic Shock**

Circulatory failure caused by severe blood loss. It may produce rapid pulse, low blood pressure, cool skin, reduced urine output, confusion, or collapse. Treatment requires urgent control of bleeding, restoration of circulating volume, blood products when indicated, and correction of associated injuries or clotting abnormalities.

### **Hemorrhagic Stroke**

A neurological deficit caused by rupture of a cerebral blood vessel, accounting for 13% of all strokes but 40% of stroke mortality. Intracerebral hemorrhage: hypertensive (basal ganglia, thalamus, pons, cerebellum), amyloid angiopathy (lobar, elderly), vascular malformations, anticoagulation. Subarachnoid hemorrhage: aneurysm rupture.

### **Hemorrhoidectomy**

Surgical excision of symptomatic hemorrhoids. Indications: Grade III-IV internal hemorrhoids (prolapsed, irreducible), external hemorrhoids with uncontrolled bleeding or recurrent thrombosis, mixed hemorrhoids.

### **Hemorrhoids (Piles)**

Vascular cushions in the anal canal composed of arteriovenous anastomoses (normal structures present from birth), which become symptomatic when they bleed, prolapse, or thrombose.

#### **Synonyms:**

Piles Piles (Hemorrhoids (Piles))

### **Hemosiderin**

A golden-brown, granular, iron-containing pigment derived from the degradation of hemoglobin and stored within macrophages as an insoluble complex. It forms when red blood cells are phagocytosed and degraded, typically in conditions of hemorrhage, hemolysis, or excessive red blood cell destruction.

### **Hemostasis**

The coordinated physiological process that stops bleeding after vascular injury through vessel constriction, platelet adhesion and aggregation, coagulation-factor activation, fibrin formation, clot

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stabilization, and regulated fibrinolysis. Failure can cause bleeding or thrombosis.

## **Hemostasis And Coagulation**

Hemostasis is the coordinated response that limits bleeding through vessel constriction, platelet adhesion and aggregation, coagulation-factor activation, fibrin formation, clot retraction, and later fibrinolysis; imbalance can cause bleeding or thrombosis.

## **Coagulation**

Coagulation is the enzymatic blood-clotting cascade that generates thrombin and converts fibrinogen to fibrin, forming a stable mesh that strengthens the platelet plug.

## **Hemostat**

A clamp used to compress a blood vessel or tissue and control bleeding.

## **Hemostat (Perineal)**

A clamp used during procedures to compress a blood vessel or hold tissue and control bleeding.

### **Synonyms:**

Perineal

## **Hemostat (Surgical)**

A clamping surgical instrument used to control bleeding by compressing a blood vessel or tissue.

### **Synonyms:**

Surgical

## **Hemostat (Vascular)**

A surgical clamp used to temporarily occlude a blood vessel and control bleeding.

### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

## **Hemothorax**

Accumulation of blood in the pleural space, most commonly from trauma. Presents with decreased breath sounds, dullness to percussion. Diagnosis: chest X-ray, ultrasound, CT. Treatment: tube thoracostomy, blood transfusion, surgery if ongoing bleeding.

## **Henoch-Schonlein Purpura**

IgA vasculitis: palpable purpura on buttocks/legs, abdominal pain, arthralgia, renal involvement (IgA nephropathy), most common in children. Self-limited in most cases; corticosteroids for severe GI/renal involvement.

### **Synonyms:**

Spring Fever (Henoch-Schonlein Purpura)

## **Henoch-SchöNlein Purpura**

An older name for IgA vasculitis, an inflammation of small blood vessels that can cause palpable purpura, usually on the lower limbs and buttocks, with joint pain, abdominal symptoms, and kidney involvement.

## **Heparin-Induced Thrombocytopenia**

An immune-mediated adverse drug reaction caused by IgG antibodies against platelet factor 4 (PF4)-heparin complexes, leading to platelet activation, thrombocytopenia, and a prothrombotic state. HIT typically occurs 5-14 days after heparin exposure (unfractionated heparin > low molecular weight heparin).

## **Hepatectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the liver for primary or metastatic tumors, requiring an adequate future liver remnant; portal vein embolization can hypertrophy the remnant before resection.

## **Hepatic Cyst**

Fluid-filled cavity in the liver most commonly congenital and asymptomatic. Simple hepatic cysts are lined by biliary epithelium and contain clear fluid. May cause pain or compressive symptoms if large or complicated by hemorrhage, infection, or rupture. Simple cysts require no treatment.

## **Hepatic Dose Adjustment**

Modification of medication selection or dosing because impaired liver function may reduce metabolism, transport, protein synthesis, or biliary excretion. Standardized liver tests do not always predict drug clearance, so drug-specific guidance is required.

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## Hepatic Drug Metabolism

The liver chemically modifies medicines through reactions such as oxidation, reduction, hydrolysis, and conjugation. These reactions can inactivate a drug, activate a prodrug, or produce an active or toxic metabolite, and are influenced by genetics, disease, age, and other medicines.

## Hepatic Encephalopathy

Neuropsychiatric syndrome occurring in advanced liver disease resulting from accumulation of neurotoxic substances, particularly ammonia. Ammonia crosses the blood-brain barrier and is metabolized by astrocytes into glutamine causing osmotic swelling and impaired neurotransmission.

## Hepatic Hemangioma

Most common benign liver tumor composed of dilated blood-filled vascular spaces lined by endothelial cells. Usually asymptomatic and found incidentally on imaging. Most are small and require no treatment.

## Hepatic Hydrothorax

Large pleural effusion occurring in patients with cirrhosis and portal hypertension in the absence of primary cardiac or pulmonary disease. Most commonly right-sided resulting from transit of ascitic fluid through small defects in the diaphragm into the pleural space driven by the pressure gradient between the abdomen and thorax.

## Hepatic Ischemia

Liver injury caused by inadequate hepatic blood flow or oxygen delivery, often during shock, severe hypoxemia, cardiac failure, or hepatic vascular occlusion. It can produce a rapid, marked rise in aminotransferases and may progress to acute liver failure.

## Hepatic Portal System

The venous network draining blood from the gastrointestinal tract, spleen, and pancreas to the liver before it reaches the systemic circulation. Formed by the union of the superior mesenteric and splenic veins behind the pancreatic neck; receives inferior

mesenteric, left gastric, and other tributaries.

## Hepatic Surgery

Surgical treatment of liver disease, including partial liver resection, transplantation, and procedures for tumors or biliary disorders. The operation depends on the diagnosis, tumor extent, liver function, and overall health.

## Hepatic Synthetic Dysfunction

Impaired hepatic production of proteins and other molecules, including albumin and coagulation factors. It may cause hypoalbuminemia, edema, prolonged prothrombin time, and increased INR, although INR can also be altered by vitamin K deficiency, anticoagulants, and other conditions.

## Hepatic Trauma

Liver injury from trauma. CT staging guides management. Grades I-V based on injury severity.

## Hepatic Vein

Veins draining the liver into the inferior vena cava. The right, middle, and left hepatic veins emerge from the posterior surface of the liver at the bare area and drain into the IVC just below the diaphragm. They carry deoxygenated blood leaving the liver (after the hepatic portal system delivers blood for processing).

## Hepatitis

Hepatitis is inflammation of the liver caused by viruses, alcohol, medications, toxins, metabolic disease, or autoimmunity and may be acute or chronic.

## Hepatitis (Viral Hepatitis)

Inflammation of the liver caused by hepatotropic viruses. Hepatitis A (HAV): fecal-oral, acute self-limited, no chronic carrier state; vaccine-preventable. Hepatitis B (HBV): blood/sexual/perinatal transmission; acute and chronic infection; leading cause of cirrhosis and HCC.

### Synonyms:

Viral Hepatitis



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## Hepatitis A

Hepatitis A is an acute fecal-oral viral liver infection that usually resolves without chronic disease but can cause severe cholestatic or fulminant hepatitis. fecal-oral route (contaminated food or water). Incubation 15-50 days. Presents with fever, malaise, nausea, jaundice, and elevated transaminases. Self-limited; does not cause chronic infection.

## Hepatitis A Virus

Picornavirus transmitted through the fecal-oral route most commonly via contaminated food or water. The incubation period is fifteen to fifty days. Clinical presentation ranges from asymptomatic infection in young children to symptomatic acute hepatitis with jaundice, fatigue, nausea, elevated transaminases, dark urine, and pale stools.

## Hepatitis A, B, C, D, E

Five viruses that can cause viral hepatitis. They differ in transmission, risk of chronic infection, prevention, and treatment.

## Hepatitis B

Hepatitis B is a blood- and body-fluid-borne viral liver infection that may become chronic and lead to cirrhosis, liver failure, or hepatocellular carcinoma. contact, and perinatally. Can cause acute (self-limited or fulminant) and chronic infection (defined by HBsAg positivity >6 months). Chronic HBV leads to cirrhosis and hepatocellular carcinoma.

## Hepatitis B Vaccine

Recombinant vaccine given at birth, 1-2 months, and 6-18 months. Protects against hepatitis B virus, which can cause chronic liver disease, cirrhosis, and hepatocellular carcinoma. Also prevents perinatal transmission when given to infants of HBsAg-positive mothers within 12 hours of birth, plus hepatitis B immune globulin.

## Hepatitis B Vaccine (Birth Dose)

The first dose of the hepatitis B vaccine is recommended within 24 hours of birth for all medically stable infants. Administered IM in the vastus lateralis. Prevents perinatal transmission of HBV. For

infants born to HBsAg-positive mothers: HBIG (0.5 mL IM) is given within 12 hours of birth along with the vaccine.

## Synonyms:

Birth Dose

## Hepatitis B Virus

Hepadnavirus transmitted through percutaneous exposure, sexual contact, and perinatally causing acute and potentially chronic hepatitis. The virus has a partially double-stranded circular DNA genome.

## Hepatitis C

Hepatitis C is a blood-borne viral infection that frequently becomes chronic and can cause progressive fibrosis, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer. exposure (IV drug use, blood transfusion before 1992). Acute infection is often asymptomatic; 50-80% progress to chronic hepatitis. Chronic HCV can lead to cirrhosis and hepatocellular carcinoma over decades. Diagnosis: anti-HCV antibody, HCV RNA.

## Hepatitis C Virus

Flavivirus transmitted primarily through percutaneous exposure with injection drug use being the most common route. Approximately seventy to eighty percent of acute infections progress to chronic hepatitis C, the leading cause of cirrhosis, hepatocellular carcinoma, and liver transplantation in many Western countries.

## Hepatitis D Virus

Defective RNA virus requiring co-infection with hepatitis B to replicate, using hepatitis B surface antigen for its envelope. Hepatitis D causes more severe liver disease than hepatitis B alone with accelerated progression to cirrhosis and higher risk of hepatocellular carcinoma.

## Hepatitis E Virus

A non-enveloped RNA virus transmitted mainly by the fecal-oral route, often through contaminated water or food. It causes acute hepatitis and, in some people, chronic infection or severe disease.



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Clinical presentation may resemble hepatitis A, with jaundice and elevated transaminases.

### Hepatitis Serology

Panel of serologic markers for hepatitis A, B, C, and E. HAV: anti-HAV IgM (acute), anti-HAV IgG (past infection/vaccination). HBV: HBsAg (active infection), anti-HBs (immunity/vaccination), anti-HBc IgM (acute), anti-HBc IgG (past), HBeAg (high replication), anti-HBe (low replication). HBV DNA: quantifies viral load.

### Hepatitis Viruses

Hepatitis A: fecal-oral, acute self-limited, vaccine (inactivated). Hepatitis B: blood/sexual/perinatal. Acute: HBsAg, IgM anti-HBc. Chronic: HBsAg >6 months, HBV DNA, HBeAg. Treatment: entecavir, tenofovir (TAF/TDF) - suppress DNA, prevent cirrhosis/HCC.

### Hepatobiliary Scintigraphy

Liver/gallbladder imaging using Tc-99m mebrofenin or disofenin. Assess biliary patency, gallbladder function, bile leak, acute cholecystitis (non-visualization of gallbladder).

### Hepatoblastoma

A malignant embryonal liver tumor occurring almost exclusively in infants and young children, associated with elevated AFP and prematurity.

### Hepatocellular Carcinoma

Primary liver cancer arising from hepatocytes. Risk factors: cirrhosis, chronic hepatitis B/C, alcohol, and metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease. Surveillance with ultrasound and AFP; treatment includes resection, transplantation, ablation, TACE, and systemic therapy.

### Hepatocellular Jaundice

Jaundice caused by dysfunction of hepatocytes, impairing the liver's ability to take up, conjugate, or excrete bilirubin. See Jaundice for complete overview. Causes: viral hepatitis (A, B, C, D, E), alcoholic hepatitis, drug-induced liver injury (paracetamol, isoniazid), cirrhosis, autoimmune hepatitis, Wilson

disease, haemochromatosis.

### Hepatojugular Reflux

Sustained pressure applied over the liver for 15-30 seconds causes a sustained rise in JVP of more than 3 cm above baseline. It indicates right heart failure or fluid overload, reflecting the inability of the right ventricle to accommodate increased venous return.

### Hepatoma

A tumor arising from liver cells, usually referring to hepatocellular carcinoma, the most common primary malignant liver tumor.

### Hepatomegaly

Enlarged liver detected on imaging. Causes: fatty liver, hepatitis, congestion, infiltration, malignancy.

### Hepatopulmonary Syndrome

Triad of liver disease, intrapulmonary vascular dilatation, and impaired oxygenation causing hypoxemia. Presents with platypnea which is dyspnea worsening in the upright position and orthodeoxia which is oxygen desaturation in the upright position.

### Hepatorenal Syndrome

A form of acute or chronic kidney dysfunction associated with advanced liver disease and portal hypertension, without another sufficient cause of renal failure. It reflects altered circulation and renal blood flow and requires prompt assessment and treatment of both the liver disease and kidney dysfunction.

### Hepatosplenomegaly

Enlargement of both the liver and spleen. It may result from infection, portal hypertension, storage disease, malignancy, haemolysis, or systemic inflammatory and infiltrative disorders; evaluation depends on associated symptoms and laboratory and imaging findings.

### Hepatotoxicity

Liver injury caused by a drug, toxin, chemical, or other exposure. Acetaminophen is an important cause of acute liver failure in some regions. Evalua-

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tion may include liver tests, clotting studies, medication review, and clinical assessment.

### **HER2-Positive**

A cancer whose cells have increased expression or amplification of human epidermal growth factor receptor 2 (HER2). Some HER2-targeted medicines may be used according to the cancer type and clinical context.

### **Herd Immunity**

Resistance of population to invasion by infectious agent when sufficient proportion immune. Threshold varies by disease (measles 95%, polio 80%).

### **Hereditary Angioedema**

Recurrent episodes of nonpitting swelling of the skin, gastrointestinal tract, or upper airway caused most often by deficiency or dysfunction of C1 inhibitor. Attacks can cause abdominal pain, vomiting, airway obstruction, or life-threatening laryngeal edema without typical urticaria.

### **Hereditary Cancer**

Cancer caused by inherited genetic mutations. Genetic counseling recommended.

### **Hereditary Hemorrhagic Telangiectasia**

An autosomal dominant vascular disorder (also called Osler-Weber-Rendu syndrome) characterized by telangiectasias on skin and mucous membranes, pulmonary AVMs, hepatic AVMs, and cerebral AVMs. Pulmonary AVMs can cause hypoxemia and paradoxical emboli. Treatment is embolization of pulmonary AVMs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Osler-Weber-Rendu syndrome).

### **Hereditary Hemorrhagic Telangiectasia (Osler-Weber-Rendu Disease)**

An autosomal dominant vascular dysplasia characterized by malformed blood vessels lacking smooth muscle layers. Mutations in ENG (endoglin) or ACVRL1 (ALK1) genes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Osler-Weber-Rendu Disease

### **Hereditary Spherocytosis**

The most common inherited hemolytic anemia in Northern Europeans (autosomal dominant 75%, recessive 25%). Caused by defects in RBC membrane proteins (spectrin, ankyrin, band 3, protein 4.2), leading to loss of membrane surface area, reduced deformability, and premature destruction in the spleen.

### **Hermansky-Pudlak Syndrome**

Autosomal recessive (10+ genes: HPS1-10, BLOC/AP-3 complexes). Oculocutaneous albinism, bleeding disorder (absent dense bodies in platelets -> prolonged bleeding time), pulmonary fibrosis (HPS-1, HPS-4), granulomatous colitis, neutropenia. Diagnosis: electron microscopy of platelets (absent dense bodies), genetic testing.

### **Hernia**

A hernia is protrusion of tissue through a weakness or opening in the surrounding muscle or connective tissue and may become incarcerated or strangulated. cavity that normally contains it. Most hernias occur in the abdominal wall.

### **Hernia Mesh**

Synthetic or biologic material for hernia repair. Polypropylene most common. Complications: infection, recurrence, chronic pain, mesh migration.

### **Hernia Repair (Herniorrhaphy)**

Surgical repair of a hernia (inguinal, femoral, umbilical, incisional, hiatal). Inguinal hernia repair: open (Lichtenstein tension-free mesh, Shouldice, Bassini) or laparoscopic (TEP: totally extraperitoneal, TAPP: transabdominal preperitoneal). Mesh reinforcement reduces recurrence (1-3% for mesh vs. 5-15% for primary tissue repair).

#### **Synonyms:**

Herniorrhaphy

### **Herniated Disc**

Protrusion of the nucleus pulposus through a tear in the annulus fibrosus of the intervertebral disc,

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causing compression or inflammation of adjacent nerve roots. Most common at L4-L5 and L5-S1 (lumbar) and C5-C6, C6-C7 (cervical). Lumbar: sciatica (radiating leg pain), paresthesias, sensory loss, and motor weakness (foot drop).

### **Herniated Disk**

A herniated disk occurs when spinal disk material extends through a fissure and may compress a nerve root, producing back pain, radiating pain, numbness, or weakness. intervertebral disc, most commonly occurring in the lumbar spine (L4-L5 and L5-S1 account for 95 percent of lumbar herniations) and cervical spine (C5-C6 and C6-C7), potentially compressing spinal nerves.

### **Herpangina**

A common childhood viral illness caused by Coxsackievirus A (enterovirus), presenting with fever, sore throat, and small vesicles or ulcers on the soft palate and posterior pharynx. It is most common in children and spreads through respiratory and fecal-oral secretions.

### **Herpes**

Infection caused by a herpesvirus. The term commonly refers to herpes simplex infection, which causes oral or genital lesions, but other herpesviruses cause distinct diseases.

### **Herpes Gestationis**

An autoimmune blistering skin disease of pregnancy mediated by anti-basement membrane zone antibodies, presenting with pruritic urticarial plaques and vesicles, typically in the second or third trimester.

### **Herpes Simplex**

Infection with herpes simplex virus type 1 or type 2, commonly causing recurrent oral or genital vesicles and ulcers.

### **Herpes Simplex (Cold Sores / Genital Herpes)**

A viral infection caused by herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1, typically orofacial, though increasingly anogenital) and type 2 (HSV-2, predominantly

anogenital). HSV is a double-stranded DNA virus of the Herpesviridae family with latency in sensory ganglia and periodic reactivation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cold Sores / Genital Herpes

### **Herpes Simplex Encephalitis**

The most common cause of sporadic fatal encephalitis, caused by herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) in over ninety percent of cases. The virus typically infects the temporal lobes, orbitofrontal cortex, and insular cortex, causing hemorrhagic necrosis.

### **Herpes Simplex Skin Infection**

Infection of skin or mucosa by herpes simplex virus, producing grouped vesicles or erosions on an erythematous base. Recurrent disease commonly affects the oral or genital region; widespread infection in patients with eczema is eczema herpeticum and requires urgent medical assessment.

### **Herpes Simplex Virus**

A double-stranded DNA virus belonging to the Herpesviridae family that causes oral and genital herpes. HSV has two serotypes: HSV-1, which typically causes oral herpes, and HSV-2, which typically causes genital herpes. The virus establishes latent infections in sensory ganglia and can reactivate periodically.

### **Herpes Simplex Virus Infection**

Infection with herpes simplex virus type 1 or type 2, commonly causing recurrent oral, genital, skin, eye, or central nervous system disease.

### **Herpes Vegetans**

A rare, chronic, verrucous or vegetative form of herpes simplex virus infection occurring in immunocompromised patients, particularly those with HIV/AIDS. It presents as exophytic, proliferative, ulcerative plaques on the genital or perianal skin, often refractory to standard antiviral therapy.

### **Herpes Zoster**

A painful, usually one-sided blistering rash caused by reactivation of latent varicella-zoster virus in a

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sensory nerve ganglion. It typically follows a band-like distribution and may cause persistent nerve pain after the rash resolves.

**Synonyms:**

Shingles (Herpes Zoster)

**Herpes Zoster (Shingles)**

A painful, vesicular rash caused by reactivation of latent varicella-zoster virus (VZV, human herpesvirus 3) in the dorsal root ganglia.

**Synonyms:**

Shingles

**Herpes Zoster Ophthalmicus**

Reactivation of varicella-zoster virus latency in the trigeminal ganglion, with viral spread along the ophthalmic division (V1) causing painful vesicular skin eruption on the forehead, eyelid, and nose, with potential ocular involvement including keratitis, uveitis, and secondary glaucoma.

**Herpetic Glossitis**

Inflammation of the tongue caused by herpes simplex virus infection, presenting with painful vesicles and ulceration on the tongue surface, often recurring in immunocompromised patients.

**Herpetic Whitlow**

A painful viral infection of the finger caused by the herpes simplex virus (typically HSV-1), characterized by swelling, redness, and painful vesicular lesions on the finger.

**Hesitation Wounds**

Multiple superficial, tentative parallel incised cuts surrounding a deeper primary fatal cut wound, classically observed in suicides involving sharp instruments (wrists, neck).

**Heteroplasmy**

The presence of more than one mitochondrial DNA sequence in a cell or person, usually because mutant and normal mitochondrial genomes coexist.

**Heterotopic Pregnancy**

Simultaneous intrauterine and ectopic pregnancy. Rare in spontaneous conception (1:30,000) but more common with ART (1:100-1:500). Risk factors: ovulation induction, IVF with multiple embryo transfer. The presence of an intrauterine pregnancy does not exclude an ectopic pregnancy.

**Heterozygous**

Having two different alleles of a particular gene at a genetic locus. The observable effect depends on the gene and the relationship between the alleles.

**Hexokinase**

Phosphorylates glucose to glucose-6-phosphate. Low  $K_m$ , inhibited by product. Glucokinase (liver) has high  $K_m$ , not inhibited.

**Hiatal Hernia**

Protrusion of part of the stomach through the esophageal opening in the diaphragm into the chest. It may be sliding or paraesophageal and can be associated with reflux or other symptoms.

**Hiatus Hernia**

Another term for hiatal hernia: protrusion of part of the stomach through the esophageal hiatus of the diaphragm into the chest. It may be sliding or paraesophageal.

**Hib**

*Haemophilus influenzae* type b, an encapsulated bacterium that can cause meningitis, epiglottitis, pneumonia, septic arthritis, cellulitis, or sepsis. Routine conjugate vaccination substantially reduces invasive Hib disease.

**Hiccough (Hiccup)**

An involuntary, repetitive, spasmodic contraction of the diaphragm followed by sudden closure of the glottis, producing the characteristic 'hic' sound. Hiccups are caused by irritation or stimulation of the phrenic nerve (C3-C5, innervates the diaphragm) or the vagus nerve (CN X).

**Synonyms:**

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Hiccup

### **Hiccups**

Involuntary, spasmodic contractions of the diaphragm followed by sudden closure of the glottis, producing a characteristic sound. Persistent or intractable hiccups may reflect irritation of the diaphragm or phrenic and vagal pathways, metabolic disease, medication exposure, or central nervous system disease.

### **Hiccups (Singultus)**

Involuntary, spasmodic contractions of the diaphragm and intercostal muscles followed by sudden glottic closure, producing the characteristic "hic" sound. The reflex arc involves the phrenic nerve (C3-C5), vagus nerve, and brainstem centers.

#### **Synonyms:**

Singultus

### **Hidradenitis**

Hidradenitis suppurativa is a chronic inflammatory follicular occlusion disease affecting apocrine gland-bearing areas (axillae, groin, inframammary). It presents with recurrent painful nodules, abscesses, sinus tracts, and scarring.

### **Hidradenitis Suppurativa**

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder involving recurrent painful nodules, abscesses, draining tunnels, and scars, usually in skin folds such as the axillae, groin, buttocks, or breasts. Severity varies and is influenced by genetic, hormonal, and environmental factors.

### **High Arch**

An abnormally elevated medial longitudinal arch of the foot, also called pes cavus. It may be idiopathic or associated with neuromuscular disease and can cause overload of the heel and forefoot, calluses, pain, instability, or difficulty fitting footwear.

#### **Synonyms:**

pes cavus.

### **High-Dependency Unit**

A ward or area within a hospital that provides a level of care between a general ward and an intensive care unit, for patients who require intensive observation or treatment but not mechanical ventilation.

### **High-Flow Nasal Cannula**

A device delivering heated and humidified oxygen at flow rates up to 60 L/min through a nasal cannula. It provides a modest amount of PEEP, reduces dead space ventilation, and improves patient comfort compared to non-invasive ventilation. It is used for acute hypoxemic respiratory failure and post-extubation support.

### **High-Intensity Focused Ultrasound**

A treatment that concentrates ultrasound energy to heat and destroy a targeted area of tissue. Its uses depend on the device, disease, and clinical setting.

### **High-Level Disinfection**

Disinfection that inactivates all microorganisms except high numbers of bacterial spores. It is commonly used for heat-sensitive semicritical equipment such as some flexible endoscopes after meticulous cleaning.

### **Hill-Sachs Lesion**

Impaction fracture of posterolateral humeral head from anterior shoulder dislocation. Associated with Bankart lesion.

### **Hip Dislocation**

Loss of normal congruence between the femoral head and acetabulum. It is usually traumatic in adults and may damage the sciatic nerve or femoral-head blood supply; congenital or developmental dislocation occurs in developmental dysplasia of the hip.

### **Hip Disorders**

The hip joints are ball-and-socket joints connecting the femur to the pelvis, providing stability and a wide range of motion for walking, running, and weight-bearing activities. Common hip conditions include osteoarthritis, fractures, bursitis, and labral



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tears.

### **Hip Dysplasia**

Developmental dysplasia of the hip (DDH): abnormal development of the acetabulum/femoral head causing instability, subluxation, or dislocation. Risk factors: female, breech presentation, family history, firstborn, and tight swaddling.

#### **Synonyms:**

CHD DDH

### **Hip Fracture**

Fracture of proximal femur, usually femoral neck or intertrochanteric region. Mechanism: low-energy fall in osteoporotic bone. Symptoms: pain, inability to bear weight, shortened/externally rotated leg. Diagnosis: X-ray, MRI if X-ray negative. Treatment: surgical fixation (internal fixation, arthroplasty).

#### **Synonyms:**

Broken Hip

### **Hip Joint**

Multiaxial ball-and-socket synovial joint between femoral head and acetabulum. Designed for stability and mobility, bearing entire upper body weight. Acetabular labrum deepens the socket; strong ligaments (iliofemoral, pubofemoral, ischiofemoral) reinforce it. Ligamentum teres contains the femoral head artery.

### **Hip Prosthesis**

Total hip replacement components: femoral stem (metal), head (metal/ceramic), acetabular cup (polyethylene/metal/ceramic). Fixation: cemented (older patients), cementless (younger, porous coating for bone ingrowth). Materials: cobalt-chrome, titanium, ceramics.

### **Hip Replacement**

A surgical procedure in which the diseased hip joint is replaced with a prosthetic implant (arthroplasty). Total hip replacement (THR) replaces both the femoral head and the acetabulum.

### **Hip-Fracture Rehabilitation**

Multidisciplinary postoperative management aimed at restoring mobility, preventing complications, and returning the older person to the highest feasible level of independence. It includes early mobilization, pain control, osteoporosis treatment, delirium prevention, nutrition, and discharge planning.

### **Hippocampus**

Curved medial temporal lobe structure, part of the limbic system, critical for new declarative memory formation (episodic and spatial) and short-to-long-term memory conversion. Has dentate gyrus, hippocampus proper (CA1-CA4), subiculum, and entorhinal cortex. One of few adult neurogenesis sites (dentate gyrus).

### **Hippotherapy**

Therapeutic horseback riding for neurological, musculoskeletal conditions. Improves balance, posture, coordination.

### **Hirschsprung Disease**

Congenital condition characterized by the absence of enteric ganglion cells in a segment of the distal colon, resulting from failure of neural crest cell migration during embryonic development.

#### **Synonyms:**

Congenital Megacolon (Hirschsprung Disease)

### **Hirschsprung's Disease**

A congenital disorder characterized by the absence of parasympathetic ganglion cells (aganglionosis) in the distal colon, resulting in failure of relaxation and functional obstruction. Incidence: 1 in 5,000 live births, male predominance (4:1).

### **Hirsutism**

Excess terminal hair growth in women in a male-pattern distribution (face—upper lip, chin, sideburns; chest, back, lower abdomen, inner thighs). Hirsutism affects 5-10% of women of reproductive age. Pathophysiology: increased androgen production or increased end-organ sensitivity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Excess Facial Hair In Women



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## Histamine

A biogenic amine (imidazolyethylamine) synthesised from L-histidine by histidine decarboxylase, stored in basophils, mast cells, and platelets, and released during allergic and inflammatory responses.

## Histiocytosis

A group of disorders characterized by abnormal proliferation of histiocytes (tissue macrophages/dendritic cells), including Langerhans cell histiocytosis, Erdheim-Chester disease, and hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis.

## Histology

The microscopic study of the structure of tissues and cells. Histology involves preparing thin tissue sections (3-10 micrometres) by fixation (formalin, paraffin embedding), sectioning (microtome), staining (haematoxylin and eosin, H&E), and examination under a light or electron microscope.

## Histopathology

The laboratory-based diagnosis of disease through microscopic examination of tissue sections from biopsy, excision, or autopsy, built on fixation, paraffin embedding, sectioning, and hematoxylin and eosin staining.

## Histoplasma Capsulatum

A fungus found in soil contaminated with bird or bat droppings that can cause histoplasmosis when its spores are inhaled.

## Histoplasmosis

A fungal infection caused by *Histoplasma capsulatum*, acquired by inhaling spores found in nitrogen-rich soil enriched with bat or bird guano, most commonly in the Ohio and Mississippi River valleys of the United States, Central and South America, and parts of Africa and Asia.

## Histrionic Personality Disorder

A pattern of excessive emotionality and attention-seeking.

## HIV

Human immunodeficiency virus: a retrovirus (HIV-1, HIV-2) causing progressive CD4+ T-cell depletion and AIDS if untreated. Transmitted via sexual contact, blood/blood products, mother-to-child.

## HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus)

A retrovirus (family Retroviridae, genus Lentivirus) that causes acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS) by infecting and destroying CD4+ T lymphocytes (helper T cells). Two types: HIV-1 (pandemic, most common worldwide) and HIV-2 (less virulent, West Africa).

### Synonyms:

Human Immunodeficiency Virus

## HIV Infection

Infection with human immunodeficiency virus, which progressively damages immune function if untreated. Antiretroviral therapy suppresses viral replication and reduces transmission and complications.

## HIV Test

Screening and confirmatory testing for HIV. Fourth-generation HIV antigen/antibody combo test (p24 antigen + HIV-1/2 antibodies): window period 2-4 weeks. Positive screening requires confirmatory HIV-1/2 antibody differentiation assay. Rapid point-of-care tests (fingerstick, oral swab): results in 20 minutes.

## HIV/AIDS

HIV-1/2: retrovirus, CD4+ T cell depletion. Transmission: sexual, blood, perinatal, breast milk. Acute retroviral syndrome: fever, lymphadenopathy, pharyngitis, rash, high viral load. Clinical latency: CD4 decline over years. AIDS: CD4 <200 or AIDS-defining illness (PJP, toxo, CMV, MAC, crypto, KS, lymphoma, TB).

## HIV/AIDS Immunopathogenesis

HIV-1 infects CD4+ T cells, macrophages, dendritic cells via gp120 binding to CD4 + CCR5 (R5-tropic, early) or CXCR4 (X4-tropic, late). Reverse transcription -> integration -> transcription/translation

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-> budding. Acute retroviral syndrome (2-4 weeks): fever, lymphadenopathy, pharyngitis, rash, high viral load.

### **HIV/AIDS Nutrition**

Malnutrition due to increased need requirement, malabsorption, side effects. Supplementation, opportunistic infection management.

### **Hives**

Hives, or urticaria, are transient raised itchy wheals caused by dermal edema, commonly from allergy, infection, medications, physical triggers, or spontaneous mast-cell activation. or chronic and can result from infection, foods, medications, physical triggers, or autoimmune mechanisms; swelling of the airway is an emergency.

#### **Synonyms:**

Angioedema (Hives)

### **Hives (Urticaria)**

A common skin condition characterized by transient, well-circumscribed, intensely pruritic wheals that blanch with pressure and resolve within 24 hours without scarring, caused by mast-cell mediator release in the dermis. Acute urticaria lasts less than 6 weeks; chronic urticaria recurs for 6 weeks or longer and is often spontaneous.

#### **Synonyms:**

Urticaria

### **HLA-B27**

A class I human-leukocyte-antigen molecule associated with several spondyloarthropathies, including ankylosing spondylitis and reactive arthritis. A positive result supports but does not establish a diagnosis.

### **HMG-CoA Reductase**

Rate-limiting enzyme of cholesterol synthesis. Target of statin drugs.

### **Hoarding Disorder**

Persistent difficulty discarding or parting with possessions, regardless of their actual value. The indi-

vidual perceives a need to save items and experiences distress at the thought of discarding them. This results in accumulation of possessions that congest and clutter active living areas.

### **Hoarseness**

A change in vocal quality due to abnormal vibration of the vocal folds, resulting in altered pitch; a subset of dysphonia rather than a diagnosis. Common causes include acute viral laryngitis, voice overuse, smoking, reflux, and vocal cord lesions (nodules, polyps, papillomas, laryngeal carcinoma).

### **Hodgkin Lymphoma**

A B-cell lymphoma characterized by the presence of Reed-Sternberg cells (large, binucleate or multinucleate cells with owl-eye nucleoli) in a background of reactive inflammatory cells.

### **Hodgkin's Lymphoma**

A B-cell lymphoma characterized by the presence of Reed-Sternberg cells (large, binucleate or multinucleate cells with owl-eye nucleoli) in a background of reactive inflammatory cells. See Hodgkin Lymphoma.

### **Holoprosencephaly**

A structural brain malformation resulting from incomplete or failed division of the forebrain (prosencephalon) into the cerebral hemispheres during the fifth week of gestation.

### **Holosystolic Murmur Differential**

Pansystolic (holosystolic) murmurs are plateau-shaped and extend from S1 to S2.

### **Holt-Oram Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant disorder caused by TBX5 gene mutations, characterized by congenital heart disease and upper limb malformations. Cardiac anomalies: atrial septal defect (most common), VSD, and conduction abnormalities (heart block, atrial fibrillation).

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## Holter Monitor

Continuous ECG recording for 24-48 hours to detect arrhythmias, quantify burden (atrial fibrillation, PVCs, PACs), and correlate symptoms with rhythm. Patient diary logs symptoms. Indications: palpitations, syncope, presyncope, and assessment of arrhythmia control. Reveals paroxysmal arrhythmias not captured on standard 12-lead ECG.

## Holter Monitoring

Portable, continuous electrocardiographic recording over an extended period, commonly 24 hours or longer, to detect intermittent rhythm abnormalities and correlate them with symptoms.

## Homeostasis

The maintenance of stable internal conditions despite external changes. Key regulated variables: temperature, pH, glucose, electrolytes, blood pressure, fluid balance. Mechanisms: negative feedback loops (most common), positive feedback (rare, e.g., labor, blood clotting).

## Homocystinuria

An autosomal recessive metabolic disorder caused by deficiency of cystathionine beta-synthase (CBS), leading to accumulation of homocysteine and methionine.

## Homozygous

Having two identical alleles of a particular gene (AA or aa). Can be homozygous dominant or homozygous recessive.

## Hookworm

Intestinal nematode infection by *Ancylostoma duodenale* or *Necator americanus*, acquired by skin penetration of filariform larvae (walking barefoot on contaminated soil).

## Hookworm Infection

Intestinal infection caused by hookworms acquired when larvae in contaminated soil penetrate the skin or are ingested. Chronic infection can cause abdominal symptoms, iron-deficiency anemia, protein loss, and impaired growth in children.

## Hookworm Infestation

Intestinal infection by hookworm nematodes, which attach to the intestinal wall and may cause iron-deficiency anemia, abdominal symptoms, or poor growth.

## Hordeolum (Stye)

A tender, localized infection or inflammation of an eyelid gland that produces a small red lump near the eyelid margin.

### Synonyms:

Stye

## Horizontal Gene Transfer

The transfer of genetic material between bacteria through mechanisms other than parent-to-offspring transmission. The three mechanisms are transformation (uptake of free DNA), transduction (transfer via bacteriophages), and conjugation (direct cell-to-cell transfer).

## Hormone

Chemical messenger secreted by endocrine glands into blood, acting on distant target organs with specific receptors. Classes: peptides/proteins (insulin, GH), steroids (cortisol, estrogen), amines (thyroid hormone, catecholamines). Mechanisms: cell surface receptors (GPCRs, RTKs) or intracellular receptors (nuclear receptors).

## Hormone Replacement Therapy

HRT (menopause hormone therapy): estrogen  $\pm$  progestin to relieve menopausal symptoms (vasomotor, vaginal atrophy, sleep, mood) and prevent osteoporosis. Regimens: estrogen-only (post-hysterectomy) or combined (with progestin for endometrial protection in uterus-intact women); routes: oral, transdermal, vaginal.

## Hormone Therapy

Treatment blocking hormone effects in hormone-sensitive cancers. Examples: tamoxifen (breast cancer), leuprolide (prostate cancer), aromatase inhibitors.

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### Hormone-Receptor Positive

A cancer whose cells express receptors for hormones such as estrogen or progesterone. Hormone-blocking treatment may be useful for selected cancers with these receptors.

### Hormone-Sensitive Lipase

Breaks down triglycerides in adipose tissue. Activated by glucagon, epinephrine via cAMP.

### Horner Syndrome

A clinical triad caused by disruption of the sympathetic pathway to the eye and face, resulting in ipsilateral miosis (constricted pupil), ptosis (drooping of the upper eyelid due to paralysis of the superior tarsal muscle), and anhidrosis (loss of sweating on the affected side of the face).

#### Synonyms:

Oculosympathetic Palsy

### Horseshoe Kidney

The most common renal fusion anomaly (1 in 400-500), where the lower poles of both kidneys are fused across the midline by an isthmus of renal parenchyma or fibrous tissue.

### Hospice

Palliative care for terminal illness with prognosis <6 months. Focus on comfort, quality of life, support for patient and family. Provided at home, hospice facility, or hospital. Interdisciplinary team: physician, nurse, social worker, chaplain, volunteer.

### Hospice Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation in hospice setting. Symptom management, positioning, caregiver education.

### Hospital-Acquired Infection

Infection acquired during hospitalization. Also: healthcare-associated infection (HAI). Examples: CLABSI, CAUTI, surgical site infection.

### Hospital-Acquired Infections

Infections that develop during or after hospitalisation. Major types include central line-associated

bloodstream infections, catheter-associated urinary tract infections, ventilator-associated pneumonia, and surgical site infections. Risk factors include invasive devices, prolonged hospitalisation, and antimicrobial use.

### Hospital-Acquired Pneumonia

Pneumonia developing > 48 hours after hospital admission. Common pathogens include *Pseudomonas* and MRSA. Empiric treatment covers resistant organisms.

### Hospitalization (Geriatric)

Inpatient stay for elderly patients. High risk for adverse outcomes: delirium, functional decline, institutionalization. Precautions: fall prevention, early mobilization, medication reconciliation, delirium prevention, nutrition support. Geriatrician consultation beneficial.

#### Synonyms:

Geriatric

### Host

A person or other living organism that can be infected by a virus or other pathogen under natural conditions. The host may be a human, animal, or plant. In medical contexts, the host is the patient in whom an infection or disease develops.

### Host Response

Immunological reaction to implant. Foreign body response, encapsulation, rejection.

### Hot Flashes

Vasomotor symptoms: sudden sensations of intense heat, sweating, flushing, and palpitations, most commonly from estrogen withdrawal around menopause; also in hypogonadism, chemotherapy-induced ovarian failure, and some medications (SERMs, GnRH agonists). Mechanism: hypothalamic thermoregulatory dysfunction.

#### Synonyms:

Menopause Hot Flashes (Hot Flashes)

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## Hounsfield Units

CT number scale referencing water (0 HU) and air (-1000 HU). Fat: -50 to -100 HU. Water: 0 HU. Soft tissue: +20 to +50 HU. Bone: +400 to +3000 HU.

## Howell-Jolly Bodies

Basophilic nuclear remnants (clusters of DNA) normally removed from circulating red blood cells by splenic macrophages (pitting). Presence on peripheral blood smear indicates functional asplenia or anatomical splenectomy (e.g., trauma, sickle cell auto-splenectomy). Also seen in severe megaloblastic anemia.

## HPLC

High-performance liquid chromatography for radiochemical purity analysis.

## HPV

Human papillomavirus is a group of DNA viruses that infect skin and mucous membranes. Some types cause warts, whereas persistent infection with high-risk types can cause precancerous lesions and cancers of the cervix, anus, penis, vulva, vagina, or oropharynx.

## HPV Vaccine

Human Papillomavirus vaccine given at 11-12 years (can start at 9), with series completion by 15 years. Two-dose series if started before 15; three-dose series if started at 15 or older. Protects against HPV types causing cervical cancer, oropharyngeal cancer, and genital warts. Gardasil 9 covers nine HPV types.

## HRT

Hormone replacement therapy uses estrogen, with a progestogen when needed, to treat selected menopausal symptoms caused by declining ovarian hormone production. It can relieve vasomotor and genitourinary symptoms and help prevent bone loss, but benefits and risks depend on the person's age, medical history, regimen, and duration of use.

## Human Chorionic Gonadotropin

A glycoprotein hormone produced by trophoblast cells after implantation. Detectable in serum 8-11

days post-conception and in urine 12-14 days. Levels double approximately every 48-72 hours in early pregnancy, peaking at 8-11 weeks then plateauing.

## Human Immunodeficiency Virus

A retrovirus belonging to the Lentivirus genus that causes acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS). HIV has two species: HIV-1 and HIV-2. The virus targets CD4+ T cells, macrophages, and dendritic cells. HIV has a complex genome encoding structural proteins, enzymes (reverse transcriptase, integrase, protease), and regulatory proteins.

## Human Microbiome

The collection of microorganisms that live on and in the human body. The microbiome includes bacteria, viruses, fungi, and archaea. The gut microbiome is the most studied and plays a role in digestion, immune function, and disease.

## Human Papillomavirus

The most common STI, with over 100 types. High-risk types (16, 18) cause cervical, oropharyngeal, anal, and genital cancers. Low-risk types (6, 11) cause genital warts. Prevention: HPV vaccine (Gardasil 9) protects against 9 HPV types. Screening: Pap smear and HPV testing for cervical cancer prevention.

## Human Placental Lactogen

A peptide hormone produced by the placenta that contributes to mammary-gland development and shifts maternal metabolism toward increased lipolysis and reduced insulin sensitivity during pregnancy. It supports nutrient availability for the fetus and contributes to physiologic gestational insulin resistance.

## Humeroradial Joint

Between capitulum and radial head, allowing flexion-extension and contributing to pronation-supination via radial head rotation. Radial collateral ligament provides lateral stability. Capitulum has articular cartilage only anteriorly.



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## Humeroulnar Joint

Uniaxial hinge between trochlea and trochlear notch of the ulna, allowing only flexion/extension (0 to approximately 145 degrees). Ulnar collateral ligament is the primary valgus restraint. Trochlear notch provides inherent bony stability, making it the most congruent elbow joint.

## Humerus

Single upper arm bone, the longest of the upper limb. Proximal end: head, anatomical/surgical necks, tubercles. Shaft: deltoid tuberosity, radial groove, epicondyles. Distal end: trochlea, capitulum, olecranon fossa. The surgical neck is the common fracture site potentially injuring the axillary nerve.

## Humoral Immunity

The component of adaptive immunity mediated by antibodies produced by B lymphocytes (plasma cells) that neutralize extracellular pathogens and toxins. Humoral responses defend against bacteria, viruses outside cells, and parasites.

## Hunger

Physiological drive to eat. Regulated by ghrelin, blood glucose, stomach distension. Psychological factors also influence.

## Hungry Bone Syndrome

Severe hypocalcemia occurring after parathyroidectomy particularly in patients with severe preoperative hyperparathyroidism and high bone turnover. Rapid bone remineralization after removal of excess PTH sequesters calcium and phosphorus from the serum causing symptomatic hypocalcemia.

## Hunter Syndrome

Mucopolysaccharidosis type II (MPS II), an X-linked recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by iduronate-2-sulfatase deficiency (IDS gene mutations). Accumulation of dermatan sulfate and heparan sulfate (same as Hurler).

## Huntington Disease

Autosomal dominant neurodegenerative disorder caused by CAG trinucleotide repeat expansion in

HTT gene. Onset: 30-50 years. Symptoms: chorea, dementia, psychiatric disease. Anticipation: earlier onset in successive generations (paternal transmission). No cure; symptomatic treatment.

## Huntington's Disease

An autosomal dominant neurodegenerative disorder caused by a CAG trinucleotide repeat expansion in the huntingtin gene on chromosome 4p16.3. The disease is characterized by the triad of progressive chorea, cognitive decline, and psychiatric manifestations.

### Synonyms:

Chorea, Huntington's

## Huntington's Disease (Chorea)

An autosomal dominant neurodegenerative disorder caused by a CAG trinucleotide repeat expansion (>36 repeats, normally <26) in the HTT gene on chromosome 4 (4p16.3), which encodes the huntingtin protein.

### Synonyms:

Chorea

## Hurler Syndrome

Mucopolysaccharidosis type I (MPS I), the severe form, an autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by alpha-L-iduronidase deficiency (IDUA gene mutations). Accumulation of dermatan sulfate and heparan sulfate leads to progressive multisystem involvement.

## Hyaline Cartilage

The most common type of cartilage, containing fine type II collagen fibers in a firm, glassy matrix. It supports airways, covers articular surfaces, and forms much of the fetal skeleton and growth plates.

## Hyaline Casts

Transparent colorless cylindrical structures composed primarily of Tamm-Horsfall protein secreted by the thick ascending limb. Most common type of urine cast. Normal in concentrated urine and after exercise. Increased in dehydration, prerenal states, and volume depletion.



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### **Hyaline Membrane**

A layer of protein-rich material lining damaged alveoli, classically seen in respiratory distress syndrome. It impairs gas exchange.

### **Hyaline Membrane Disease**

An older name for neonatal respiratory distress syndrome, caused mainly by surfactant deficiency in premature infants. See Respiratory Distress Syndrome.

### **Hydatid Cyst**

A cyst caused by the larval stage of *Echinococcus granulosus*, a tapeworm transmitted from dogs to humans through ingestion of contaminated food. The liver is the most commonly affected organ, followed by the lungs. Cysts grow slowly and may become symptomatic from mass effect or rupture, causing anaphylaxis.

### **Hydatidiform Mole**

A form of gestational trophoblastic disease in which abnormal trophoblastic tissue grows in the uterus. A complete mole has no viable fetus; a partial mole may contain abnormal fetal tissue. Both require follow-up because persistent disease can occur.

### **Hydranencephaly**

A rare congenital condition where the cerebral hemispheres are nearly completely absent, replaced by thin-walled, fluid-filled sacs, while the brainstem, basal ganglia, and cerebellum are relatively preserved. Caused by bilateral internal carotid artery occlusion in utero (vascular insult, infection, or twin-twin transfusion).

### **Hydrocele**

A collection of serous fluid within the tunica vaginalis surrounding the testis. Congenital hydrocele results from patent processus vaginalis; acquired hydrocele may follow infection, trauma, or tumor. Transilluminates on examination. Ultrasound confirms fluid collection.

### **Hydrocephalus**

Accumulation of cerebrospinal fluid within the ven-

tricular system, leading to increased intracranial pressure. Communicating hydrocephalus: impaired CSF absorption (subarachnoid hemorrhage, meningitis, leptomeningeal carcinomatosis).

### **Hydrocolpos**

Distension of the vagina with fluid due to obstruction of the vaginal outlet, often from an imperforate hymen or transverse septum, presenting as a pelvic mass in neonates or adolescents.

### **Hydrofluoric Acid Exposure**

Contact with hydrofluoric acid, which can cause deep tissue injury and systemic fluoride toxicity, including dangerous low calcium and cardiac arrhythmias.

### **Hydrogen Bond**

Weak electrostatic interaction between a hydrogen atom covalently bonded to an electronegative atom (N, O, F) and another electronegative atom. Critical for protein structure (alpha helix, beta sheet), DNA double helix (base pairing), enzyme-substrate binding, and water properties (high boiling point, solvent properties).

### **Hydrogen Breath Test**

Non-invasive test for carbohydrate malabsorption (lactose, fructose) and small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO). Patient ingests a substrate (lactose, glucose, or lactulose). Breath hydrogen is measured at baseline and 15-30 minutes for 2-3 hours. Rise in H<sub>2</sub> >20 ppm from baseline: positive (bacterial fermentation).

### **Hydronephrosis**

Dilation of renal collecting system proximal to obstruction. Causes include stones, strictures, malignancy, and BPH. Graded on ultrasound from mild to severe. Prolonged obstruction leads to cortical thinning and renal failure. Bilateral more clinically significant.

### **Hydrophobia**

Painful spasms or fear triggered by attempts to drink, classically occurring in advanced rabies be-

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cause of inflammation of the brain and nerves involved in swallowing.

### **Hydropneumothorax**

The simultaneous presence of both fluid and air in the pleural space, causing respiratory distress and dullness to percussion with absent breath sounds, typically requiring chest tube drainage.

### **Hydrops Fetalis**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in two or more fetal compartments, including pleural effusion, pericardial effusion, ascites, and subcutaneous edema. Causes include Rh isoimmunization, chromosomal abnormalities, cardiac defects, infections (parvovirus B19), and twin-to-twin transfusion syndrome.

### **Hydrotherapy**

Exercise in water using buoyancy, resistance, warmth. Benefits: reduced weight-bearing, improved circulation, pain relief, increased range of motion. Used for arthritis, spinal cord injury, amputation, neurological conditions.

### **Hydroxocobalamin**

A cobalt-containing form of vitamin B12 used as an antidote for cyanide poisoning. It binds cyanide to form cyanocobalamin, which is excreted in urine; it can cause red discoloration of skin and body fluids and interfere with some laboratory tests.

### **Hymen**

A thin fold of mucous membrane that partially covers the external opening of the vagina. The hymen is a remnant of fetal development, with no known physiological function in postnatal life.

### **Hyoid Bone**

U-shaped bone in the anterior neck at C3, unique for not directly articulating with any other bone. Suspended by muscles and the stylohyoid ligament. Provides attachment for suprahyoid (digastric, stylohyoid, mylohyoid, geniohyoid) and infrahyoid (sternohyoid, sternothyroid, thyrohyoid, omohyoid) muscles.

### **Hyper-IgM Syndromes**

A group of disorders characterized by normal or elevated IgM with low IgG, IgA, and IgE, due to defective class switch recombination (CSR) and somatic hypermutation (SHM).

### **Hyperaldosteronism**

Hyperaldosteronism, also known as Conn syndrome when caused by an adrenal adenoma, is characterized by excessive aldosterone production causing hypertension, hypokalemia, and metabolic alkalosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Conn syndrome when caused by an adrenal adenoma, is.

### **Hyperaldosteronism Complications**

Beyond hypertension and hypokalemia, primary hyperaldosteronism causes target organ damage including left ventricular hypertrophy, fibrosis, stroke, coronary artery disease, atrial fibrillation, and chronic kidney disease. These complications occur at higher rates than in essential hypertension of similar severity.

### **Hyperammonemia**

An abnormally elevated concentration of ammonia in the blood. It may result from an inherited urea-cycle or organic-acid disorder, severe liver dysfunction, or other acquired causes and can produce encephalopathy, cerebral oedema, seizures, and coma.

### **Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy**

Administration of 100% oxygen at increased atmospheric pressure. Indications: carbon monoxide poisoning, decompression sickness, gas gangrene, necrotizing soft tissue infections, delayed radiation injury, crush injury, compromised grafts. Mechanism: increases dissolved oxygen, vasoconstriction, antimicrobial effect.

### **Hypercalcemia**

Elevated serum calcium level (total calcium >10.5 mg/dL or ionized calcium >5.3 mg/dL). mnemonic MALIGNANT: Myeloma, Metastases, Metabolic bone disease, Hyperparathyroidism, Adrenal insuffi-

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ciency, Paget disease, Immobilization, Thiazide diuretics, Addison disease, Neonatal, Tumor-derived PTHrP.

**Synonyms:**

Calcium Elevated (Hypercalcemia)

### Hypercalcemia Of Malignancy

Elevated serum calcium caused by cancer, a common paraneoplastic and oncologic emergency. Mechanisms: PTHrP secretion (most common—squamous cell lung, breast, renal, ovarian), osteolytic metastases (breast, myeloma), 1,25-dihydroxyvitamin D (lymphoma), and ectopic PTH (rare).

### Hypercapnia

An abnormally elevated arterial partial pressure of carbon dioxide, usually caused by alveolar hypoventilation. It may produce headache, somnolence, confusion, asterixis, respiratory acidosis, and, when severe or rapidly developing, coma.

### Hypercholesterolemia

Elevated serum total cholesterol and LDL cholesterol levels, a major modifiable risk factor for atherosclerotic cardiovascular disease. It may be primary, due to familial hypercholesterolemia from LDL receptor mutations, or secondary to diet, obesity, hypothyroidism, or nephrotic syndrome.

### Hypercoagulable State

Condition increasing thrombosis risk. Inherited: Factor V Leiden, prothrombin mutation, protein C/S deficiency, antithrombin deficiency. Acquired: cancer, pregnancy, oral contraceptives, antiphospholipid syndrome, myeloproliferative disorders.

### Hypercyanotic Tetralogy

A complex congenital heart defect with four features: ventricular septal defect, overriding aorta, right ventricular outflow tract obstruction (pulmonary stenosis), and right ventricular hypertrophy. It causes right-to-left shunting and cyanosis. Treatment is surgical repair, typically in infancy.

### Hyperemesis

Excessive or persistent vomiting that may cause de-

hydration, electrolyte abnormalities, and nutritional deficiency.

### Hyperemesis Gravidarum

Severe, persistent nausea and vomiting during pregnancy resulting in weight loss greater than 5%, dehydration, electrolyte imbalances, and ketosis. Occurs in 0.3-2% of pregnancies, typically presenting in the first trimester. Differentiated from normal morning sickness by severity and metabolic derangement.

### Hyperesthesia

Increased sensitivity to sensory stimulation—touch (tactile), pain (hyperalgesia), or other stimuli—so that normally non-painful or mildly painful stimuli produce exaggerated discomfort.

### Hyperglycemia

Blood glucose above the expected range for the testing conditions. Acute hyperglycemia can cause osmotic diuresis, dehydration, and electrolyte disturbances. Chronic hyperglycemia leads to microvascular (retinopathy, nephropathy, neuropathy) and macrovascular complications.

### Hypergonadotropic Hypogonadism

Primary testicular failure with elevated LH/FSH. Causes: Klinefelter syndrome, cryptorchidism, orchitis, chemotherapy, radiation.

### Hyperhidrosis

Excessive sweating beyond what is needed for thermoregulation. palms, soles, axillae, and face without underlying cause. Secondary generalized hyperhidrosis is caused by medications, endocrine disorders, infections, or malignancies.

**Synonyms:**

Palm Sweating Excessive (Hyperhidrosis) Sweating, Abnormally Excessive Sole Sweating Excessive (Hyperhidrosis)

### Hyperkalemia

Serum potassium >5.0 mEq/L. ECG changes: peaked T waves, widened QRS, sine wave. Causes: renal failure, medications (ACE inhibitors, potassium-sparing diuretics), tissue breakdown, aci-

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dosis.

### **Hyperlipidemia**

Elevated levels of lipids in the blood—total cholesterol, LDL, triglycerides, and/or reduced HDL—a major modifiable risk factor for atherosclerosis and cardiovascular disease. Primary (genetic: familial hypercholesterolemia) or secondary (hypothyroidism, diabetes, nephrotic syndrome, obesity, alcohol).

### **Hypermobile Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome**

A heritable connective-tissue disorder characterized mainly by generalized joint hypermobility, instability, chronic musculoskeletal pain, and other variable features involving skin, autonomic function, or digestion. Diagnosis is clinical and requires assessment for other connective-tissue disorders and related conditions.

### **Hypernatremia**

A serum sodium concentration above the reference range, usually reflecting too little free water relative to body sodium or, less often, excess sodium. Causes include impaired water intake, diabetes insipidus, osmotic diuresis, gastrointestinal losses, and sodium administration.

### **Hyperopia**

A refractive error in which light focuses behind the retina when the eye is relaxed. See Farsightedness.

### **Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State**

Hyperglycemic emergency characterized by severe hyperglycemia greater than 600 milligrams per deciliter, hyperosmolality greater than 320 milliosmoles per kilogram, and profound dehydration without significant ketosis.

### **Hyperparathyroidism**

Excessive secretion of parathyroid hormone (PTH) leading to hypercalcemia. Classified as primary (parathyroid adenoma or hyperplasia), secondary (chronic kidney disease, vitamin D deficiency), or tertiary (autonomous PTH secretion after prolonged secondary hyperparathyroidism).

### **Hyperphosphatemia**

A phosphate concentration above the laboratory reference range, often caused by impaired renal excretion, hypoparathyroidism, tumor lysis, rhabdomyolysis, or excess intake. Consequences may include secondary hyperparathyroidism, vascular/metastatic calcification, and when combined with hypocalcemia, tetany.

### **Hyperpigmentation**

Darkening of the skin caused by increased melanin production, deposition of pigment in the dermis, or accumulation of other pigments.

### **Hyperplasia**

An increase in the number of cells in a tissue or organ, resulting in enlargement while cellular architecture may remain relatively preserved. It may be physiologic, such as hormonal endometrial proliferation, or pathologic, such as benign prostatic hyperplasia or endocrine gland hyperplasia. Hyperplasia differs from hypertrophy, which is enlargement caused primarily by increased cell size rather than increased cell number. The clinical significance depends on the cause, distribution, degree of proliferation, cellular atypia, and whether the process can regress after the stimulus is removed.

### **Hyperpolarization**

A change in membrane potential to a more negative value, moving it further from threshold and making the cell less excitable. Occurs when potassium leaves the cell (opening of voltage-gated potassium channels, as in the afterhyperpolarization after an action potential) or when chloride enters (GABA-A receptor activation).

### **Hyperprolactinaemia**

An abnormally elevated concentration of prolactin in the blood. Causes include medicines, pregnancy, hypothyroidism, pituitary tumors, and other disorders.

### **Hyperprolactinemia**

Elevated serum prolactin levels most commonly caused by prolactin-secreting pituitary adenomas

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termed prolactinomas. Other causes include medications particularly antipsychotics and metoclopramide, hypothyroidism, stalk effect from non-functioning pituitary adenomas, renal failure, and chest wall lesions.

## **Hypersensitivity**

An exaggerated or inappropriate immune response to an antigen, ranging from a mild reaction to anaphylaxis.

## **Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis**

An immune-mediated lung disease from environmental antigen inhalation (molds, bird proteins). Acute, subacute, and chronic forms exist. HRCT shows ground-glass opacities, air trapping, and centrilobular nodules. Chronic HP progresses to fibrosis.

## **Hypersensitivity Reactions**

Inappropriate or excessive immune responses causing tissue damage or disease.

## **Hypersensitivity Type I**

Type I hypersensitivity, also known as immediate hypersensitivity or allergic reactions, is mediated by IgE antibodies and mast cells, producing symptoms within minutes of allergen re-exposure.

### **Synonyms:**

immediate hypersensitivity or allergic reactions,.

## **Hypersensitivity Type II**

Type II hypersensitivity, also known as cytotoxic hypersensitivity, is mediated by IgG or IgM antibodies directed against antigens on cell surfaces or the extracellular matrix, causing tissue damage through complement activation, antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity, and phagocytosis.

### **Synonyms:**

cytotoxic hypersensitivity, is mediated by IgG.

## **Hypersensitivity Type III**

Type III hypersensitivity is caused by deposition of antigen-antibody immune complexes in tissues and blood vessel walls, activating complement and recruiting neutrophils that release destructive en-

zymes and reactive oxygen species.

## **Hypersensitivity Type IV**

Type IV hypersensitivity, also known as delayed-type hypersensitivity, is mediated by T lymphocytes rather than antibodies and takes 48 to 72 hours to develop after antigen exposure.

### **Synonyms:**

delayed-type hypersensitivity, is mediated by T.

## **Hypertelorism**

Increased distance between the orbits (the bony eye sockets), measured as an increased interorbital distance on imaging.

## **Hypertension**

Persistently elevated arterial blood pressure. The diagnostic threshold depends on the guideline and the measurement method; diagnosis generally requires properly obtained readings on more than one occasion or other appropriate confirmation. It increases the risk of cardiovascular, cerebrovascular, and kidney disease.

## **Hypertension (High Blood Pressure)**

Persistently elevated blood pressure, defined as systolic BP >130 mmHg or diastolic BP >80 mmHg (ACC/AHA guidelines). See Hypertension.

### **Synonyms:**

High Blood Pressure

## **Hypertension In Anesthesia**

Hypertension during anesthesia causes increased bleeding, myocardial ischemia, and stroke risk. Common causes include light anesthesia, pain, hypercarbia, hypoxia, bladder distension, shivering, and drug withdrawal (beta-blockers, clonidine).

## **Hypertensive**

Having blood pressure that is persistently above the accepted range for the clinical context.

## **Hypertensive Crisis**

Severe elevation in blood pressure (SBP >180 or DBP >120) requiring urgent medical attention. Two



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types: hypertensive emergency (with end-organ damage) and hypertensive urgency (no acute end-organ damage). Hypertensive urgency: can be managed with oral antihypertensives (captopril, clonidine, labetalol) and careful outpatient follow-up.

### **Hypertensive Emergency**

Severe hypertension (SBP >180 or DBP >120) with acute target organ damage. Organs involved: brain (hypertensive encephalopathy, stroke), heart (acute coronary syndrome, acute pulmonary edema, aortic dissection), kidneys (acute kidney injury), and eyes (papilledema).

### **Hypertensive Heart Disease**

Left ventricular hypertrophy and diastolic/systolic dysfunction resulting from chronic hypertension. LVH is an independent cardiovascular risk factor and precursor to heart failure. Diagnosis by ECG (voltage criteria) or echocardiography (wall thickness >1.1 cm). Treatment of hypertension can regress LVH.

### **Hypertensive Nephropathy**

Kidney damage caused by chronic hypertension, leading to nephrosclerosis (arteriolar hyalinosis and glomerulosclerosis). Presents with slowly progressive proteinuria (usually subnephrotic), hypertension, and gradual decline in kidney function. More common in African American patients. Diagnosis of exclusion.

### **Hypertensive Nephrosclerosis**

Kidney damage from chronic hypertension. Benign form with hyaline arteriolosclerosis. Malignant form with hyperplastic arteriolosclerosis and onion-skinning. Second leading cause of ESRD after diabetes. Tight BP control with ACE inhibitors or ARBs essential to slow progression.

### **Hypertensive Retinopathy**

Retinal changes caused by chronic or acute hypertension. Grading (Keith-Wagener-Barker): Grade I: generalized arteriolar narrowing; Grade II: arteriovenous nicking; Grade III: cotton-wool spots, flame hemorrhages, hard exudates; Grade IV: papilledema

(malignant hypertension).

### **Hyperthermia In Anesthesia**

Perioperative hyperthermia (temperature greater than 38 degrees Celsius) has multiple causes. Malignant hyperthermia (discussed separately) is the most urgent. Sepsis, thyroid storm, serotonin syndrome, neuroleptic malignant syndrome, and central fever are other causes.

### **Hyperthermic Intraperitoneal Chemotherapy**

Heated chemotherapy circulated through the peritoneal cavity during surgery, following cytoreductive surgery, for peritoneal carcinomatosis from appendiceal, colorectal, and ovarian cancers and peritoneal mesothelioma.

### **Hyperthyroidism**

Excessive thyroid hormone production causing thyrotoxicosis (elevated serum T4 and T3 concentrations). Causes include Graves disease (most common), toxic multinodular goiter, and toxic adenoma. Symptoms include weight loss, tremor, heat intolerance, palpitations, and anxiety.

#### **Synonyms:**

Overactive Thyroid (Hyperthyroidism)

### **Hyperthyroidism (Thyrotoxicosis)**

A state in which excess thyroid hormone effect causes symptoms such as heat intolerance, sweating, tremor, weight loss, or rapid heartbeat. It may result from increased thyroid production or other causes of thyrotoxicosis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Thyrotoxicosis

### **Hypertonic Saline**

Intravenous saline with a sodium concentration greater than plasma, commonly 3% sodium chloride. It is used selectively for severe symptomatic hyponatremia or other urgent indications, with careful monitoring to avoid overly rapid correction and osmotic demyelination.



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### **Hypertonic Saline Inhalation**

Nebulized 3–7% sodium chloride solution that draws water into the airway surface liquid by osmosis, improving mucociliary clearance. It is used in CF and bronchiectasis. It may cause bronchospasm and should be preceded by a bronchodilator. It reduces exacerbations in CF.

### **Hypertrichosis**

Excessive hair growth in androgen-independent areas, affecting both sexes, either congenital or acquired. Generalized: genetic syndromes, medications (minoxidil, cyclosporine, phenytoin, glucocorticoids), malnutrition, porphyria, hypothyroidism, and malignancy (paraneoplastic).

### **Hypertriglyceridemia**

Elevated serum triglyceride levels, classified as mild at 150 to 499 mg per dL, moderate at 500 to 999, and severe above 1000. Severe hypertriglyceridemia increases the risk of acute pancreatitis. Causes include obesity, diabetes, alcohol use, and genetic disorders of lipoprotein metabolism.

### **Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy**

A disease in which the heart muscle, especially the left ventricle, becomes abnormally thick and stiff. It may obstruct blood flow, impair filling, cause chest pain or breathlessness, and increase the risk of arrhythmia and sudden death.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardiomyopathy, Hypertrophic

### **Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy Genetics**

HCM is caused by mutations in genes encoding sarcomeric proteins, most commonly beta-myosin heavy chain (MYH7) and myosin-binding protein C (MYBPC3). Inheritance is autosomal dominant with variable penetrance. Genetic testing identifies causative mutations in 40–60% of cases.

### **Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy Treatment**

Management may include medicines to relieve symptoms, treatment of arrhythmias or obstruction, an implantable defibrillator for selected patients, and surgery or ablation when indicated. Treatment is

guided by symptoms, anatomy, risk, and specialist assessment.

### **Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis**

Hypertrophy and hyperplasia of the pyloric muscle causing gastric outlet obstruction, typically in young infants. Progressive nonbilious projectile vomiting, hunger after vomiting, dehydration, and hypochloremic hypokalemic metabolic alkalosis may occur.

### **Hypertrophic Scar**

Raised scar tissue confined to the original wound margins, caused by excessive collagen production during healing. Unlike keloids, hypertrophic scars regress over time and do not extend beyond wound boundaries. They are common after burns, surgery, and trauma.

### **Hypertrophy**

Enlargement of a tissue or organ caused primarily by an increase in the size of its constituent cells. It may be physiologic, as in skeletal-muscle adaptation, or pathologic, as in pressure-induced left ventricular hypertrophy. Hypertrophy can preserve function initially but may eventually cause stiffness, impaired relaxation, oxygen-demand mismatch, or mechanical compression. Evaluation considers the affected organ, underlying stimulus, functional consequences, and whether enlargement is accompanied by fibrosis, hyperplasia, or cellular injury.

### **Hyperventilation**

Excessive alveolar ventilation that reduces arterial carbon dioxide (PaCO<sub>2</sub>) below 35 mmHg, causing respiratory alkalosis. Symptoms include lightheadedness, tingling, chest tightness, and carpopedal spasm. It may result from anxiety, pain, metabolic acidosis, or pulmonary embolism.

### **Hyperventilation Syndrome**

Recurrent or persistent overbreathing that exceeds metabolic requirements, usually producing reduced arterial carbon dioxide and respiratory alkalosis in the absence of primary pulmonary disease. Symptoms may include breathlessness, chest tightness,

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dizziness, palpitations, paraesthesia, and carpopedal spasm.

### **Hyphema**

Blood in the anterior chamber of the eye, typically resulting from blunt ocular trauma that tears the blood vessels of the iris or ciliary body. It presents as a layered collection of red blood cells in the lower portion of the anterior chamber and can cause elevated intraocular pressure and corneal blood staining.

### **Hypnosis**

A state of focused attention, reduced peripheral awareness, and heightened suggestibility, resembling a trance-like state but distinct from sleep. Hypnosis is induced by a procedure (hypnotic induction) involving focused concentration, relaxation, and guided imagery.

### **Hypnotic**

A medication that induces, maintains, or improves sleep, used for insomnia.

### **Hypoactive Sexual Desire Disorder**

A sexual dysfunction characterized by persistently or recurrently deficient or absent sexual thoughts, fantasies, and desire for sexual activity, causing marked distress or interpersonal difficulty. In DSM-5, HSDD in women is merged with female sexual arousal disorder into female sexual interest/arousal disorder.

### **Hypocalcemia**

Serum calcium less than 8.5 milligrams per deciliter or ionized calcium less than 4.5 milligrams per deciliter. Causes include hypoparathyroidism, vitamin D deficiency, hypomagnesemia, hyperphosphatemia, and critical illness.

### **Hypocalcemia, Hypophosphatemia, And Hyperkalemia**

The classic electrolyte triad of acute hypoparathyroidism, most commonly occurring after thyroid or parathyroid surgery from inadvertent removal or devascularization of the parathyroid glands.

Hypocalcemia causes tetany, paresthesias, and Chvostek and Trousseau signs.

### **Hypodermis**

Subcutaneous tissue/superficial fascia, the deepest skin layer with loose connective tissue and adipose tissue. Attaches skin to underlying muscles/bones via fibrous septa. Provides thermal insulation, energy storage (fat), mechanical cushioning, and contains blood vessels, lymphatics, and nerves.

### **Hypodontia**

Congenital absence of one or more teeth. Common: third molars, maxillary lateral incisors, second premolars.

### **Hypoesthesia**

Reduced sensitivity to touch, temperature, pain, or other sensations. It may result from nerve compression, neuropathy, spinal disease, stroke, injury, or other neurologic conditions; sudden or spreading numbness requires prompt assessment.

### **Hypogammaglobulinemia**

A reduction in circulating immunoglobulins that predisposes to recurrent infections, especially with encapsulated bacteria; it may be inherited or acquired.

### **Hypogastric Region**

Central inferior region below the umbilical region, containing the urinary bladder, sigmoid colon, rectum, and in females the uterus and ovaries. Assessed for bladder distension, uterine enlargement, and pelvic masses. Suprapubic pain may indicate cystitis, calculi, or pelvic pathology.

### **Hypoglossal Nerve Injury**

Damage to the twelfth cranial nerve (CN XII), which innervates the ipsilateral intrinsic and extrinsic tongue muscles. Causes include skull base fractures, surgical trauma, tumors, or infection.

### **Hypoglossal Nerve Palsy**

Weakness or paralysis of the hypoglossal nerve (CN

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XII), leading to ipsilateral tongue weakness, atrophy, and fasciculations. Causes include tumors at the skull base or in the hypoglossal canal, surgical injury, or central lesions. Unilateral palsy causes the tongue to deviate toward the affected side on protrusion.

### **Hypoglycemia**

An abnormally low blood-glucose concentration that may cause sweating, tremor, palpitations, hunger, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness. Causes include glucose-lowering medicines, missed meals, alcohol, and critical illness. Treatment depends on the person's ability to swallow and the cause; severe or recurrent episodes require urgent assessment.

### **Hypoglycemia In Diabetes**

Blood glucose less than 70 milligrams per deciliter in patients with diabetes. Classification by level: level one less than 70, level two less than 54 which is clinically significant hypoglycemia, and level three severe hypoglycemia requiring assistance.

### **Hypoglycemia Unawareness**

Loss of the warning symptoms of hypoglycemia including tremor, sweating, and palpitations occurring in patients with recurrent hypoglycemia particularly type one diabetes. Results from attenuated counter-regulatory hormone responses particularly impaired glucagon and epinephrine responses.

### **Hypogonadism**

Reduced or absent function of the gonads, leading to inadequate production of sex hormones (testosterone in males, estrogen in females) and impaired gamete production. Male hypogonadism: low testosterone causing decreased libido, erectile dysfunction, infertility, reduced muscle mass, and osteoporosis. Female: estrogen deficiency causing amenorrhea, hot flashes, and osteoporosis.

### **Hypogonadism In Men**

Testosterone deficiency resulting from inadequate testicular function classified as primary testicular failure or secondary hypothalamic-pituitary dysfunction. Primary causes include Klinefelter syndrome, cryptorchidism, orchitis, trauma, and chemother-

apy.

### **Hypogonadism In Women**

Testosterone deficiency in women causing decreased libido, fatigue, depressed mood, and reduced sense of well-being. Causes include oophorectomy, premature ovarian insufficiency, adrenal insufficiency, hypopituitarism, and medications.

### **Hypogonadotropic Hypogonadism**

Secondary testicular failure with low/normal LH/FSH. Causes: Kallmann syndrome, pituitary tumors, obesity, medications, systemic illness.

### **Hypohidrosis**

Reduced or absent sweating, leading to heat intolerance and risk of hyperthermia. Causes include autonomic neuropathy (diabetes, Parkinson disease), skin diseases (scleroderma, burns), medications (anticholinergics), and genetic disorders (hypohidrotic ectodermal dysplasia).

### **Hypokalemia**

Serum potassium less than 3.5 mEq/L. Causes include gastrointestinal losses from vomiting and diarrhea, renal losses from diuretics, RTA, and hyperaldosteronism, intracellular shift from alkalosis and insulin, and inadequate intake.

### **Hypomagnesemia**

Serum magnesium less than 1.7 milligrams per deciliter. Causes include gastrointestinal losses from diarrhea, renal losses from diuretics and alcohol, malnutrition, and medications including proton pump inhibitors.

### **Hypomania**

Distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy lasting at least four consecutive days, observable by others but without marked functional impairment, hospitalisation, or psychotic features.

### **Hypomanic Episode**

A distinct period of abnormally elevated, expan-

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sive, or irritable mood with increased energy lasting at least four consecutive days. The episode is not severe enough to cause marked impairment in functioning or necessitate hospitalization, and there are no psychotic features. The change in functioning is observable by others.

### **Hyponatremia**

Serum sodium less than 135 mEq/L. Most common electrolyte disorder in hospitalized patients. Causes are classified by volume status: hypovolemic from GI losses and diuretics, euvolemic from SIADH and hypothyroidism, and hypervolemic from heart failure, cirrhosis, and nephrotic syndrome.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sodium Low Levels In The Blood (Hyponatremia)

### **Hypoparathyroidism**

Reduced or absent parathyroid hormone (PTH) secretion, resulting in hypocalcemia and hyperphosphatemia. Most commonly occurs after thyroid or parathyroid surgery from inadvertent removal of parathyroid glands. Autoimmune hypoparathyroidism may occur alone or as part of autoimmune polyendocrine syndrome type one.

### **Hypoparathyroidism Management**

Management aims to correct low calcium and inadequate parathyroid-hormone activity while avoiding complications. It may include calcium and active vitamin D, monitoring of calcium and kidney function, and treatment of the underlying cause; specialist guidance is often required.

### **Hypophosphatemia**

A serum phosphate concentration below the laboratory reference range, typically caused by increased renal phosphate excretion, intracellular shifting, or renal phosphate wasting. Severe deficiency can cause muscle weakness, respiratory failure, hemolysis, impaired myocardial function, and neurologic dysfunction.

### **Hypopituitarism**

Deficiency of one or more pituitary hormones due to disorders of the pituitary gland or hypothalamus.

Causes include craniopharyngiomas, pituitary surgery or radiation, traumatic brain injury, or infiltrative diseases. Growth hormone deficiency is typically the first hormone lost followed by gonadotropins then TSH and ACTH.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pituitary Insufficiency

### **Hypoplasia**

Incomplete or underdevelopment of a tissue, organ, or body structure, resulting in reduced size or functional capacity. It may be congenital, developmental, genetic, or acquired and ranges from a mild anatomical variant to severe organ dysfunction. Assessment considers the timing of onset, associated malformations, tissue function, and whether the process is isolated or syndromic.

### **Hypotrophy**

Reduction in the volume or development of a tissue or organ without complete absence of the structure. It may reflect inadequate growth, reduced trophic stimulation, chronic underuse, nutritional deficiency, vascular insufficiency, or a systemic disorder. Hypotrophy is distinguished from aplasia, in which development fails almost completely, and from atrophy, which usually describes acquired wasting after prior development. Clinical significance depends on the affected tissue, age of onset, degree of functional impairment, and whether the cause is congenital, neurologic, vascular, or metabolic.

### **Hypoplastic Left Heart Syndrome**

A severe congenital heart defect where the left heart structures (mitral valve, left ventricle, aortic valve, ascending aorta) are underdeveloped and unable to support systemic circulation. The right ventricle pumps blood to both the pulmonary and systemic circulations via a patent ductus arteriosus.

### **Hypopyon**

A layering of inflammatory cells (purulent exudate/leukocytes) in the anterior chamber of the eye, forming a visible white-to-yellow fluid level in the lower portion of the cornea. Caused by severe anterior uveitis (HLA-B27 spondyloarthropathies, Be-

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hget disease), infectious keratitis (bacterial/fungal corneal ulcers), or endophthalmitis.

### **Hyposmia**

Decreased sensitivity to odors in which olfaction is reduced but not absent, distinct from anosmia and parosmia, and the most common olfactory complaint.

### **Hypospadias**

A congenital anomaly in which the urethral meatus opens on the ventral surface of the penis (or in females, below the normal location) rather than at the tip of the glans. It is frequently associated with a curved penis or an incomplete foreskin, and severity depends on the location of the opening and associated abnormalities.

### **Hypotension**

Abnormally low blood pressure, generally systolic <90 mmHg or mean arterial pressure <65 mmHg. Causes include hypovolemia, cardiac failure, sepsis, anaphylaxis, and medications. Orthostatic hypotension is a drop upon standing. Severe hypotension (shock) requires urgent fluid resuscitation and vasopressors.

### **Hypotension In Anesthesia**

Abnormally low blood pressure occurring during anesthesia. The clinically important threshold depends on the patient, baseline pressure, duration, and surgical context.

### **Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis (HPA Axis)**

An endocrine regulatory pathway in which hypothalamic corticotropin-releasing hormone stimulates pituitary ACTH secretion, which stimulates adrenal cortisol production. Cortisol exerts negative feedback and coordinates metabolic, immune, and stress responses.

**Synonyms:**

HPA Axis

### **Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis**

### **Physiology**

The hypothalamus releases CRH in a diurnal rhythm peaking in the early morning stimulating pituitary corticotrophs to secrete ACTH which stimulates the adrenal cortex to produce cortisol. Cortisol exerts negative feedback on both the hypothalamus and pituitary suppressing CRH and ACTH release.

### **Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Gonadal Axis Physiology**

The hypothalamus releases GnRH in a pulsatile fashion stimulating pituitary gonadotrophs to secrete LH and FSH. In males LH stimulates Leydig cells to produce testosterone while FSH stimulates Sertoli cells to support spermatogenesis.

### **Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Thyroid Axis Physiology**

The hypothalamus secretes TRH stimulating pituitary thyrotrophs to release TSH which stimulates the thyroid gland to produce T4 and T3. T3 the more biologically active form is produced by peripheral conversion of T4 by deiodinase enzymes.

### **Hypothalamus**

A small region of the brain at the base of the third ventricle, bounded by the optic chiasm, mammillary bodies, and infundibulum. It weighs approximately 4 grams and is the master homeostasis regulator. Controls autonomic and endocrine systems (via the pituitary through the hypophyseal portal system), temperature, hunger, thirst, sleep-wake cycles, and emotion.

### **Hypothermia**

A core body temperature below 35 degrees Celsius, classified as mild (32 to 35), moderate (28 to 32), or severe (<28). J-wave (Osborn wave) on ECG. Management: passive rewarming (mild), active external rewarming (moderate), active internal rewarming (severe).

**Synonyms:**

Cold Exposure Low Body Temperature

### **Hypothermia In Anesthesia**

Hypothermia (core temperature less than 36 degrees



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Celsius) occurs in 50 to 80 percent of surgical patients due to anesthetic-induced thermoregulatory dysfunction and heat redistribution. Initial phase (first 30 to 60 minutes) involves core-to-peripheral heat redistribution causing 0.5 to 1.5 degree Celsius drop.

### **Hypothyroidism**

Insufficient thyroid hormone production causing decreased metabolic rate. Most common endocrine disorder, affecting up to 5 percent in the general population and up to 20 percent in women over 60 years.

### **Hypotonia**

Decreased muscle tone presenting as a floppy or poorly supported posture. It may result from muscle, peripheral nerve, neuromuscular-junction, spinal-cord, brain, genetic, or metabolic disorders and requires evaluation when persistent or associated with weakness or developmental delay.

### **Hypovolemic Shock**

Circulatory failure caused by insufficient circulating blood or fluid volume, leading to reduced tissue perfusion. Causes include hemorrhage, severe dehydration, and fluid loss.

### **Hypoxemia**

Abnormally low oxygen concentration in arterial blood. Causes include hypoventilation, ventilation-perfusion mismatch, shunting, impaired diffusion, and low inspired oxygen.

### **Hypoxia**

Inadequate oxygen availability at the tissue level. It may result from low arterial oxygen, anemia, reduced blood flow, or impaired cellular oxygen use.

### **Hypoxic Cell Injury**

Cellular injury caused by inadequate oxygen availability, reducing oxidative phosphorylation and ATP production. Causes include ischemia, hypoxemia, anemia, and impaired oxygen utilization; severity and duration determine reversibility.

### **Hypoxic Pulmonary Vasoconstriction**

The unique response of pulmonary arterioles to low alveolar oxygen tension (PO<sub>2</sub> less than approximately 60 mmHg), causing vasoconstriction.

### **Hypoxic-Ischemic Brain Injury**

Brain injury caused by inadequate oxygen delivery or cerebral blood flow. It may follow cardiac arrest, asphyxia, shock, respiratory failure, or severe hypoglycemia and can produce coma, seizures, cognitive impairment, or death.

### **Hysterectomy**

Hysterectomy is surgical removal of the uterus, sometimes with the cervix, tubes, or ovaries, performed for conditions such as cancer, fibroids, bleeding, or prolapse. women after cesarean section in the United States.

### **Hysterectomy And Surgical Menopause**

Hysterectomy is the surgical removal of the uterus, and when the ovaries are also removed (oophorectomy), it induces surgical menopause regardless of age.

### **Hysterosalpingo-Contrast-Sonography**

An ultrasound-based technique for evaluating the uterine cavity and fallopian tube patency. Sterile saline or contrast medium is injected through the cervix while transvaginal ultrasound is performed.

### **Hysterosalpingo-Contrast-Sonography (HyCoSy)**

Ultrasound evaluation of tubal patency using contrast. Alternative to hysterosalpingography.

#### **Synonyms:**

HyCoSy

### **Hysterosalpingogram**

An X-ray procedure used to evaluate the uterine cavity and fallopian tube patency. A radiopaque contrast medium is injected through the cervix, and serial X-ray images are taken as the contrast fills the uterine cavity and spills from the fallopian tubes.



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### **Hysterosalpingography**

An X-ray imaging procedure in which radiopaque contrast is injected through a cervical cannula. Used for infertility evaluation: assesses tubal patency (normal: contrast spills freely into peritoneal cavity), uterine cavity shape (fibroids, polyps, synechiae, Mullerian anomalies), and proximal/distal tubal occlusion.

### **Hallux Rigidus**

Stiffness and painful loss of motion at the joint where the big toe meets the foot.

### **Hemarthrosis**

Bleeding into a joint space.

### **Hemopericardium**

Accumulation of blood in the sac surrounding the heart.

### **Hemoperitoneum**

Accumulation of blood in the abdominal cavity.

### **Hemorrhoid**

A swollen vein in the lower rectum or anus.

### **Herpes Encephalitis**

Inflammation of the brain caused by herpes simplex virus infection.

### **Heterotaxy Syndrome**

A congenital disorder in which internal organs are arranged abnormally and may have associated heart defects.

### **Hodgkin's Disease**

A cancer of the lymphatic system characterized by abnormal lymphocytes, including Reed-Sternberg cells.

### **Horner's Syndrome**

A group of findings caused by disruption of sympathetic nerves, including a drooping eyelid, a small pupil, and reduced sweating on one side of the face.

### **Hydrothorax**

An abnormal collection of clear fluid in the pleural space around a lung.

### **Hydroureter**

Abnormal enlargement of a ureter caused by impaired urine drainage.

### **Hyperacusis**

Abnormally increased sensitivity to ordinary sounds.

### **Hyperphagia**

Excessive hunger or food intake.

### **Hyperreflexia**

Exaggerated or overactive deep-tendon reflexes.

### **Hypersomnia**

Excessive daytime sleepiness or abnormally prolonged sleep.

### **Hyperthermia**

An abnormally high body temperature caused by excess heat production or impaired heat loss.

### **Hypophosphatasia**

A rare inherited disorder of bone and tooth mineralization caused by deficient tissue-nonspecific alkaline phosphatase.

### **Health Care Proxy**

A legal appointment authorizing another person to make healthcare decisions when a patient cannot make them.

### **High-Density Lipoprotein**

A lipoprotein that transports cholesterol in the blood and is commonly called HDL.

#### **Synonyms:**

HDL.

### **Hamstring Injury**

A strain or tear of one or more muscles or tendons at the back of the thigh.

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**Synonyms:**

Pulled Hamstring (Hamstring Injury)

**Hand-Foot-And-Mouth Disease**

A contagious viral illness causing sores in the mouth and a rash on the hands and feet, usually in children.

**Heatstroke**

A life-threatening rise in body temperature caused by failure of the body's heat regulation.

**Heavy Menstrual Bleeding**

Menstrual bleeding that is unusually heavy or prolonged and interferes with daily activities.

**Synonyms:**

Excessive Menstrual Bleeding

**Hilar Cholangiocarcinoma**

A cancer of the bile ducts where the ducts leave the liver.

**Hip Labral Tear**

A tear in the ring of cartilage that surrounds the hip socket.

**Hemopoietic Stem Cell**

A stem cell that can develop into red blood cells, white blood cells, or platelets.

**Hemorrhagic Anemia**

Anemia caused by loss of blood.

**Hemosiderosis**

Excessive deposition of the iron-storage pigment hemosiderin in tissues.

**Hepatic Flexure**

The bend where the ascending colon becomes the transverse colon near the liver.

**Hepatitis D**

Liver inflammation caused by hepatitis D virus, which occurs only with hepatitis B infection.

**Hepatitis E**

Liver inflammation caused by hepatitis E virus, usually transmitted through contaminated food or water.

**Herniorrhaphy**

Surgical repair of a hernia.

**Hilum**

A depression or opening where blood vessels, nerves, ducts, or other structures enter or leave an organ.

**Hydrochloric Acid**

The acid in gastric juice that helps digest food and kill microorganisms.

**Hallux**

The great toe.

**Hematoma**

A localized collection of blood outside blood vessels, usually caused by injury or a bleeding disorder.

**Hematomyelia**

Bleeding into the spinal cord.

**Hemiballism**

A movement disorder causing sudden, large-amplitude, flinging movements on one side of the body, usually from a lesion involving the subthalamic region.

**Hertz**

The SI unit of frequency, equal to one cycle per second.

**HER2 Inhibitor**

A targeted cancer treatment that blocks signaling through human epidermal growth factor receptor 2 in cancers with HER2 overexpression or amplification.

**Hypovolemia**

Hypovolemia is reduced effective circulating blood

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volume, usually from bleeding, fluid loss, or inadequate intake; it can cause tachycardia, hypotension, poor perfusion, kidney injury, and hypovolaemic shock.

### **Homocysteine**

An amino acid formed during methionine metabolism. Persistently elevated blood levels may occur with genetic, nutritional, renal, or other disorders.

### **Hyperpnea**

Breathing that is deeper than normal and may also be faster, increasing overall ventilation.

### **Hypolipidemic Agent**

A medication that lowers blood lipids such as cholesterol or triglycerides.

### **Hypopnea**

Abnormally shallow or reduced breathing, especially when it occurs repeatedly during sleep.

### **Hypoproteinemia**

An abnormally low concentration of proteins in the blood, often involving low albumin levels.

### **Hypoventilation**

Reduced alveolar ventilation leading to elevated carbon dioxide levels in the blood, potentially causing respiratory acidosis and hypoxemia.

### **Hematosi**

The exchange of oxygen and carbon dioxide between alveolar air and pulmonary capillary blood, resulting in oxygenation of the blood.

### **Hesselbach Triangle**

A weak area of the anterior abdominal wall bounded by the lateral border of the rectus abdominis, the inferior epigastric vessels, and the inguinal ligament; direct inguinal hernias pass through it.

### **Homans Sign**

Calf pain elicited by forced ankle dorsiflexion, his-

torically associated with deep-vein thrombosis but insufficiently accurate for diagnosis and not recommended as a standalone test.

### **Hyperlordotic Posture**

An exaggerated inward curvature of the lumbar spine, often producing increased anterior pelvic tilt and a prominent lower-back arch.

### **Hantavirus Infection**

A zoonotic viral infection acquired mainly through inhalation of contaminated rodent excreta. It may cause hemorrhagic fever with renal syndrome or hantavirus pulmonary syndrome, which can progress rapidly to respiratory failure.

### **High-Altitude Pulmonary Edema**

A potentially fatal accumulation of fluid in the lungs after rapid ascent to high altitude, characterized by breathlessness, cough, reduced exercise tolerance, and sometimes frothy sputum. Immediate descent and oxygen are essential.

### **Hysteroscopy**

A clinical condition or finding involving hysteroscopy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hyperuricemia**

An abnormally high concentration of uric acid in the blood, which may be asymptomatic or contribute to gout and uric-acid kidney stones.

### **Haemoglobinuria (Hemoglobinuria)**

The presence of free hemoglobin in the urine, often causing red or dark-brown discoloration. It may result from intravascular hemolysis or other blood disorders.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hemoglobinuria

### **Haemorrhagic Disease Of The Newborn (Vitamin K Deficiency Bleeding)**

Bleeding in a newborn or young infant caused by inadequate vitamin K-dependent clotting activity.

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It may occur early, classically, or late and can involve the brain or gastrointestinal tract.

**Synonyms:**

Vitamin K Deficiency Bleeding

**Heart-Lung Machine (Cardiopulmonary Bypass Machine)**

A device that temporarily takes over the pumping and gas-exchange functions of the heart and lungs during selected cardiac operations.

**Synonyms:**

Cardiopulmonary Bypass Machine

**Heart Transplantation**

Surgical replacement of a failing heart with a donor heart, usually for selected patients with advanced heart failure who meet specialist criteria.

**Heredity**

The transmission of genetic characteristics from parents to offspring through genes and chromosomes.

**Human Leukocyte Antigen (HLA)**

A group of cell-surface proteins encoded by genes in the major histocompatibility complex. HLA molecules present antigens to T cells and are important in immune responses and tissue matching for transplantation.

**Synonyms:**

HLA

**Hydrosalpinx**

Dilatation of a fallopian tube caused by accumulation of clear fluid, usually after inflammation, infection, endometriosis, or previous pelvic surgery. It may affect fertility.

**Hypopharynx**

The lower part of the pharynx behind and beside the larynx, extending from the oropharynx to the esophagus. It directs food toward the esophagus during swallowing.

**Hypophysis (Pituitary Gland)**

An endocrine gland at the base of the brain that

regulates growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, and water balance through its hormones.

**Synonyms:**

Pituitary Gland

**Hysterotomy**

A surgical incision into the uterus, performed in selected obstetric or gynecologic procedures.

**Habit**

A repeated behavior or pattern of action that may be ordinary, helpful, or harmful; in clinical assessment, its frequency, control, and effect on functioning determine whether it is a concern.

**Haemophilus Aegyptius**

haemophilus aegyptius is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

**Haemophilus Haemolyticus**

haemophilus haemolyticus is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

**Haemophilus Infections**

haemophilus infections is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

**Haemophilus Paragallinarum**

haemophilus paragallinarum is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

**Haemophilus Parainfluenzae**

haemophilus parainfluenzae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause

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disease.

### **Haemophilus Somnus**

haemophilus somnus is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Haemophilus Vaccine**

haemophilus vaccine is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Hafnia**

A biomedical term referring to hafnia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Hafnia Alvei**

A biomedical term referring to hafnia alvei; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Hair**

Keratinized filaments produced by follicles in the skin. Hair protects the scalp, contributes to temperature regulation and sensation, and grows through anagen, catagen, and telogen phases.

### **Hair Disease**

A clinical condition involving hair Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Halcinonide**

A potent topical corticosteroid used to reduce inflammation and itching in steroid-responsive dermatitis and other inflammatory skin disorders; prolonged or extensive use can cause skin atrophy and systemic effects.

### **Hallermann's Syndrome**

A rare congenital disorder characterized by distinctive craniofacial development, sparse hair, dental

abnormalities, and sometimes eye or skeletal findings; it is also called Hallermann–Streiff syndrome.

### **Hallucinogen**

A psychoactive substance that can alter perception, thought, and mood and may produce hallucinations; effects and toxicity vary by substance, dose, co-ingestants, and mental state.

### **Hallux Varus**

Abnormal medial deviation of the great toe, often following surgery, trauma, neuromuscular imbalance, or congenital deformity; it can cause shoe difficulty and pressure-related pain.

### **Halobacillus**

halobacillus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Halobacteriaceae**

halobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Halofenate**

An investigational lipid-lowering drug related to fenofibrate that was studied for effects on triglycerides and cholesterol but is not a routine current treatment.

### **Halofuginone Hydrobromide**

A clinical condition or finding involving halofuginone hydrobromide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Halogen**

An element in group 17 of the periodic table, including fluorine, chlorine, bromine, iodine, and astatine; halogens and their compounds have medical, bio-

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logic, and toxicologic importance.

### **Halogenation**

A chemical reaction that adds a halogen such as chlorine, bromine, or iodine to a molecule; in biology it can alter drug activity, metabolism, or biomolecular function.

### **Haloperidol**

Haloperidol is a first-generation antipsychotic that blocks dopamine D2 receptors and is used for psychosis, agitation, delirium, and tics; extrapyramidal reactions, tardive dyskinesia, hyperprolactinaemia, and QT prolongation are important risks.

### **Halothane**

A volatile inhaled anesthetic formerly used to induce or maintain general anesthesia; it can cause hypotension, arrhythmias, and rare severe immune-mediated liver injury.

### **Hamartomatous Polyposis**

A condition in which multiple hamartomatous gastrointestinal polyps develop from disorganized but benign tissue overgrowth, sometimes as part of an inherited cancer-predisposition syndrome.

### **Hand**

hand refers to hand, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Hand Deformity**

A hand deformity is abnormal shape, alignment, movement, or function of the hand caused by congenital difference, injury, arthritis, nerve disease, or other conditions.

### **Hannaella Luteola**

A biomedical term referring to hannaella Luteola; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

### **Hanseniaspora**

A biomedical term referring to hanseniaspora; its

classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Hanseniaspora Uvarum**

A biomedical term referring to hanseniaspora uvarum; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Hanseniaspora Valbyensis**

A biomedical term referring to hanseniaspora valbyensis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Haploidentical Donor**

A clinical condition or finding involving haploidentical donor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Haploidy**

A clinical condition or finding involving haploidy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hapten**

A hapten is a small molecule that is not immunogenic by itself but can trigger an immune response after binding to a larger carrier protein, as in some drug allergies.

### **Haptoglobin Analyses**

Laboratory tests measuring haptoglobin, a plasma protein that binds free hemoglobin; low values can support evaluation of intravascular hemolysis but are also affected by liver disease and inflammation.

### **Haptoglobin Decreased**

A low blood haptoglobin result, commonly caused by intravascular red-cell destruction, reduced hepatic production, or severe liver disease; it is interpreted with hemoglobin, bilirubin, reticulocytes, and a blood smear.



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## Hard Palate

The hard palate is the bony front portion of the roof of the mouth that separates the oral and nasal cavities and helps with chewing and speech.

## Harderian Gland

A gland associated with the eye in many vertebrates that produces lipid-rich secretions; it is not a normal distinct gland in the same form in humans.

## Hardness

A measurable resistance to deformation, used in medicine and materials science; in clinical contexts it may describe tissue induration, a hard mass, or hard stool depending on the setting.

## Harringtonines

A group of plant-derived polyol esters and related alkaloid compounds investigated for anticancer activity; their pharmacology and toxicity depend on the individual compound.

## Hashimoto Disease

An autoimmune disorder in which antibodies and lymphocytes progressively damage the thyroid, commonly causing hypothyroidism, goiter, fatigue, cold intolerance, constipation, and weight change.

## Hashitoxicosis

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving hashitoxicosis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

## Head

The body region containing the brain, eyes, ears, nose, mouth, skull, and face, connected to the trunk by the neck and supplied by major cranial nerves and vessels.

## Head Movement

Motion of the head produced mainly by the cervical spine and neck muscles, including flexion, extension, rotation, and side bending; pain or restricted movement may indicate injury or disease.

## Health Care

The prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and ongoing support provided to maintain or improve health, delivered by professionals, institutions, public-health systems, and informal caregivers.

## Health Care Facility

A place where health services are delivered, such as a clinic, hospital, laboratory, nursing facility, or rehabilitation center; its services and level of care determine appropriate referrals.

## Health Care Personnel

Professionals and support workers involved in patient care, including clinicians, nurses, therapists, technicians, aides, and public-health staff.

## Health Education

The process of giving people understandable information and skills to prevent illness, recognize symptoms, use treatment safely, and make informed health decisions.

## Health Services Research

Research that evaluates how healthcare is organized, financed, delivered, accessed, and experienced, including quality, safety, outcomes, cost, and inequity.

## Health Survey

A biomedical term referring to health Survey; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Health Workforce

A biomedical term referring to health Workforce; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Healthy

A biomedical term referring to healthy; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Hearing

The sensory perception of sound produced when

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vibrations stimulate the cochlea and auditory nerve and are interpreted by the brain; hearing loss may be conductive, sensorineural, or mixed.

### **Hearing Disorder**

A condition that reduces or distorts hearing through disease of the outer or middle ear, cochlea, auditory nerve, or central pathways; audiometry and examination help distinguish conductive from sensorineural loss.

### **Hearing Test**

An audiologic assessment that measures hearing thresholds and speech perception across frequencies to identify conductive, sensorineural, or mixed hearing loss.

### **Heart Aneurysm**

A localized bulging or outpouching of a weakened heart wall, often after myocardial infarction or from cardiomyopathy, that can impair contraction or form clots and arrhythmias.

### **Heart Catheterization**

A procedure in which a catheter is passed through a blood vessel into the heart to measure pressures, assess coronary arteries, inject contrast, obtain samples, or perform treatment.

### **Heart Contraction**

The coordinated systolic shortening of cardiac muscle that ejects blood from the ventricles into the pulmonary artery and aorta; electrical activation and calcium handling control it.

### **Heart Injury**

Damage to heart muscle or surrounding cardiac structures caused by trauma, ischemia, inflammation, toxins, or procedures; symptoms and tests depend on the injured tissue and severity.

### **Heart Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting heart neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Heart Rhythm**

The rate and pattern of cardiac electrical activation and contraction, normally initiated by the sinoatrial node; abnormal rhythms include bradycardia, tachycardia, atrial fibrillation, and ventricular arrhythmias.

### **Heart Septum**

The muscular or membranous wall separating the right and left sides of the heart, including the atrial and ventricular septa; defects can permit abnormal blood flow between chambers.

### **Heart Tamponade**

Life-threatening compression of the heart by fluid, blood, or gas in the pericardial space, restricting filling and causing hypotension, raised venous pressure, tachycardia, and shock.

### **Heart Valve Disorder**

Abnormal narrowing, leakage, or structural deformation of a cardiac valve that can impair forward blood flow or enlarge the heart and cause murmur, breathlessness, fatigue, or edema.

### **Heart Ventricle**

One of the two lower heart chambers that pumps blood to the lungs or systemic circulation; the right ventricle pumps to the pulmonary artery and the left to the aorta.

### **Heat Shock Protein**

A stress-response protein that helps other proteins fold, avoid aggregation, and recover after heat, oxidative, infectious, or other cellular stress; some also influence immunity and cancer biology.

### **Heberden's Node**

A hard, bony enlargement of the distal interphalangeal joint caused by osteoarthritis, usually affecting the fingers and sometimes producing pain, stiffness, or reduced dexterity.

### **Hedgehog Proteins**

A family of secreted developmental signaling pro-

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teins, including Sonic hedgehog, that regulate embryonic patterning, tissue differentiation, and selected stem-cell and cancer pathways.

### Height

The vertical distance from the base of a person to the top of the head, measured for growth assessment, nutritional evaluation, drug dosing, and calculation of body-mass index.

### Hela Cell

A continuously dividing human cell line derived from cervical cancer cells of Henrietta Lacks and widely used in biomedical research, virology, and drug testing.

### Helcococcus

helicococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helcococcus Kunzii

helicococcus kunzii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helcococcus Pyogenes

helicococcus pyogenes is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helcococcus Sueciensis

helicococcus sueciensis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicase

An enzyme that uses energy from nucleoside triphosphates to separate paired nucleic-acid strands during DNA replication, repair, recombination, or RNA processing.

### Helicobacter

helicobacter is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicobacter Cinaedi

helicobacter cinaedi is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicobacter Felis

helicobacter felis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicobacter Fennelliae

helicobacter fennelliae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicobacter Mustelae

helicobacter mustelae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Helicobacter Rappini

helicobacter rappini is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial

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susceptibility.

### **Helicobacteraceae**

helicobacteraceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Helium**

A chemically inert gas used in respiratory mixtures, cryogenics, imaging, and laboratory applications; inhalation can displace oxygen and cause hypoxia despite its lack of direct toxicity.

### **Heller Myotomy**

A clinical condition or finding involving heller myotomy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Helminth**

A named microorganism or biological taxon; identification depends on its morphology, genetic or biochemical features, host, and site, while clinical importance depends on infection, colonization, or exposure.

### **Helminthiasis**

A named microorganism or biological taxon; identification depends on its morphology, genetic or biochemical features, host, and site, while clinical importance depends on infection, colonization, or exposure.

### **Helper Virus**

helper virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Hemagglutination Test**

A test in which antibodies or other agents cause red blood cells to clump; the reaction can help detect antibodies, antigens, or selected infectious agents.

### **Hemagglutinin**

A surface glycoprotein, especially on influenza viruses, that binds sialic-acid receptors and helps the virus attach to and enter host cells; it is a major target of protective antibodies.

### **Hemangioendothelioma**

A vascular neoplasm arising from endothelial cells with malignant potential between benign hemangioma and high-grade angiosarcoma; behavior depends on subtype and site.

### **Hemangiopericytoma**

A rare tumor formerly defined by branching “staghorn” vessels and perivascular cells; many lesions classified this way are now recognized as solitary fibrous tumors.

### **Hematocolpos**

Accumulation of menstrual blood in the vagina, usually because an imperforate hymen or another obstructing anomaly prevents outflow; it may cause cyclic pelvic pain and a bulging vaginal membrane.

### **Hematogenous**

Spread through the bloodstream, as when infection, tumor cells, or embolic material travels from one body site to another.

### **Hematologic Agents**

Medicines or biologic therapies that act on blood cells, coagulation, marrow, or immune pathways, including agents used for anemia, thrombosis, leukemia, and lymphoma.

### **Hematologic Response**

A measurable improvement or change in blood counts or marrow findings after treatment, such as recovery of neutrophils, platelets, or hemoglobin or reduction of malignant cells.

### **Hematological Disease**

A disorder of blood cells, bone marrow, lymphatic tissue, or coagulation, including anemia, leukemia, lymphoma, bleeding disorders, and clotting disorders.

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ders.

### **Hematologic Malignancy**

Alternate index label; see *Blood Cancer* and relevant leukemia, lymphoma, or myeloma entries.

### **Hematologist**

A physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of blood, bone marrow, lymph nodes, clotting, and hematologic cancers.

### **Hematopoietic Growth Factor**

A cytokine or medicine that stimulates production, maturation, or survival of blood-forming cells in bone marrow, such as erythropoietin or granulocyte colony-stimulating factor.

### **Hematopoietic Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting hematopoietic neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Hematopoietic System**

The bone marrow and related organs and cells that produce, mature, circulate, and remove blood cells, including red cells, white cells, and platelets.

### **Hematoporphyrin Derivative**

A porphyrin-based photosensitizer that accumulates in some tumors and can be activated by light in photodynamic treatment; it may also cause prolonged photosensitivity.

### **Hematosalpinx**

Accumulation of blood within a fallopian tube, often caused by ectopic pregnancy, endometriosis, pelvic surgery, or obstruction, and potentially producing pelvic pain or infertility.

### **Hematoxylin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving hematoxylin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Heme**

Heme is an iron-containing porphyrin group that binds oxygen in haemoglobin and myoglobin and forms the functional centre of several enzymes; abnormal heme metabolism contributes to porphyrias and jaundice.

### **Hemerythrin**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemerythrin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemianopsia**

Loss of vision in half of the visual field of one or both eyes, usually from a lesion of the optic tract, radiations, or occipital cortex; sudden onset may indicate stroke.

### **Hemidesmosome**

A specialized junction that anchors basal epithelial cells to the underlying basement membrane by linking intracellular keratin filaments with extracellular matrix proteins.

### **Hemifacial Atrophy**

Progressive wasting of skin, subcutaneous tissue, muscle, and sometimes bone on one side of the face, also called Parry–Romberg syndrome.

### **Hemihypertrophy**

Unequal overgrowth of one side or region of the body, producing asymmetry of limbs, trunk, or face; some childhood cases carry increased risk of embryonal tumors.

### **Hemilaryngectomy**

hemilaryngectomy is used in relation to hemilaryngectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Hemimandibulectomy**

hemimandibulectomy is used in relation to hemimandibulectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

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### **Hemimegalencephaly**

A rare developmental brain malformation in which one cerebral hemisphere is abnormally enlarged and dysplastic, often causing infantile seizures, developmental impairment, and contralateral neurologic signs.

### **Hemimelia**

A congenital limb-reduction defect in which part or all of a limb segment is absent, such as fibular or radial hemimelia.

### **Hemipelvectomy**

hemipelvectomy is used in relation to hemipelvectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Hemispherectomy**

hemispherectomy is used in relation to hemispherectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Hemisternebra**

A congenital or developmental partial segment of the sternum, caused by incomplete formation or fusion of sternal elements and sometimes associated with chest-wall anomalies.

### **Hemivertebrae**

Congenital vertebrae formed from only part of the normal vertebral body, producing wedge-shaped bone and potentially causing congenital scoliosis or spinal-cord abnormalities.

### **Hemocyanin**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemocyanin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemocytometer**

A ruled counting chamber used with a microscope to determine the concentration of cells or other particles in a measured volume of fluid.

### **Hemodialysis Clearance**

The volume of plasma from which hemodialysis removes a solute per unit time; it depends on blood and dialysate flow, membrane properties, treatment time, and the substance's distribution.

### **Hemodialysis Solution**

The dialysate fluid circulated across a semipermeable membrane during hemodialysis to remove waste and help correct electrolyte, acid-base, and fluid abnormalities.

### **Hemodynamics**

Study of blood flow dynamics within the cardiovascular system; includes assessment of blood pressure, cardiac output, and vascular resistance. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Hemoglobin A**

Haemoglobin A is the predominant adult haemoglobin, composed of two alpha and two beta chains (alpha<sub>2</sub>beta<sub>2</sub>), and transports oxygen in normal red blood cells.

### **Hemoglobin C**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemoglobin c. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemoglobin H**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemoglobin h. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemoglobin Increased**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemoglobin increased. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemoglobin M**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemoglobin m. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.



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## Hemoglobin S

Haemoglobin S is a beta-globin variant caused by the HbS mutation; when deoxygenated it can polymerize, producing sickling, haemolysis, and vaso-occlusion in sickle-cell disease.

## Hemoglobin Trait

A clinical condition or finding involving hemoglobin trait. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemoglobinuria

Haemoglobinuria is free haemoglobin in urine, usually from intravascular haemolysis; urine may be dipstick-positive for blood with few or no red cells, and causes include transfusion reactions, malaria, and paroxysmal nocturnal haemoglobinuria.

## Hemolymph

A clinical condition or finding involving hemolymph. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemolysin

A clinical condition or finding involving hemolysin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemolytic Index

A clinical condition or finding involving hemolytic index. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemopexin

A clinical condition or finding involving hemopexin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemophilus

A biomedical term referring to hemophilus; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Hemophilus Ducreyi

A biomedical term referring to hemophilus Ducreyi;

its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Hemopoietic Tissue

Tissue that produces blood cells, chiefly bone marrow, containing stem cells and supporting cells that generate erythrocytes, leukocytes, and platelets.

## Hemoprotein

A protein containing a heme group with an iron atom, such as hemoglobin, myoglobin, cytochromes, and many oxidoreductive enzymes.

## Hemorrhagic Disorder

A condition that causes abnormal bleeding because of platelet number or function, clotting-factor deficiency, excessive fibrinolysis, or blood-vessel fragility.

## Hemorrhoidal Hemorrhage

Rectal bleeding from enlarged or injured hemorrhoidal vessels, usually bright red and associated with defecation; heavy, persistent, painful, or unexplained bleeding requires evaluation for other causes.

## Hemospermia

A clinical condition or finding involving hemospermia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemostasis Valve

A clinical condition or finding involving hemostasis valve. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hemostatic Agent

A haemostatic agent promotes control of bleeding by supporting clot formation, providing a physical barrier, or inhibiting fibrinolysis; examples include topical agents, tranexamic acid, and factor replacement.

## Hempa

A historical or context-dependent biomedical abbreviation or term; its meaning must be confirmed

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from the source because it does not identify one universally accepted diagnosis or treatment.

### **Henipavirus**

henipavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Hepadnaviridae**

hepadnaviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Heparan Sulfate**

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan in cell surfaces and extracellular matrix that binds growth factors, regulates signaling, and contributes to filtration-barrier and connective-tissue structure.

### **Heparin Binding**

A medicine or chemical compound called heparin binding. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Heparin Lyase**

A medicine or chemical compound called heparin lyase. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Hepatic**

Pertaining to the liver; hepatic function includes metabolism, detoxification, bile production, and protein synthesis. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Hepatic Artery**

The artery that supplies oxygenated blood to the liver, arising from the celiac circulation and dividing into right and left branches within the porta hepatis.

### **Hepatic Fissure**

A hepatic fissure is a groove or cleft on the liver surface that separates anatomical regions and provides passage for vessels, ducts, or ligaments.

### **Hepatic Lamina**

The hepatic lamina is an embryologic or microscopic layer involved in formation and organization of liver tissue and bile ducts.

### **Hepatic Necrosis**

Death of liver cells caused by severe ischemia, toxins, viral infection, autoimmune injury, or other insults; extensive necrosis can produce acute liver failure.

### **Hepatitis G Virus**

hepatitis G virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Hepatitis Virus**

hepatitis virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Hepatobiliary System**

The connected liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts that produce, store, transport, and secrete bile and process many nutrients, drugs, and toxins.

### **Hepatocellular Adenoma**

A benign liver-cell tumor, seen more often in women using estrogen-containing medicines and in some metabolic disorders, that can bleed or rarely undergo malignant transformation.

### **Hepatocyte**

A hepatocyte is the main functional cell of the liver, carrying out metabolism, detoxification, bile production, and synthesis of many blood proteins.

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### **Hepatodiaphragmatic Nodule**

A nodule located at the interface of the liver and diaphragm; it may represent an accessory liver tissue, benign lesion, inflammatory focus, or metastatic deposit, so imaging and context matter.

### **Hepatolenticular Degeneration**

Wilson disease, an inherited ATP7B disorder causing copper accumulation in the liver, brain, cornea, and other tissues, with hepatic, neurologic, psychiatric, or Kayser–Fleischer-ring findings.

### **Hepatovirus**

hepatovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Hepcidin**

A liver-produced peptide hormone that controls systemic iron balance by binding ferroportin and reducing intestinal iron absorption and iron release from macrophages.

### **Herbal Supplement**

A concentrated plant-derived product marketed for health or symptom relief; composition and evidence vary, and contamination, drug interactions, liver injury, and pregnancy risks must be considered.

### **Herbaspirillum**

A biomedical term referring to herbaspirillum; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Herbaspirillum Huttiense**

A biomedical term referring to herbaspirillum huttiense; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Herbicide**

A chemical used to kill or control unwanted plants; exposure can irritate skin, eyes, lungs, or the gas-

trointestinal tract, with toxicity determined by the specific compound and dose.

### **Hereditary**

Transmitted through genetic material from a parent or arising from an inherited variant; a hereditary trait may be dominant, recessive, X-linked, mitochondrial, or multifactorial.

### **Hereditary Coproporphyria**

An inherited hepatic porphyria, usually caused by reduced coproporphyrinogen oxidase activity, that can cause episodic neurovisceral attacks and, in some people, photosensitive skin symptoms.

### **Hereditary Elliptocytosis**

An inherited red-cell membrane disorder in which erythrocytes are elliptical on the blood smear; most people are asymptomatic, but hemolytic anemia can occur in severe forms.

### **Hereditary Hyperbilirubinemia**

An inherited disorder of bilirubin production, conjugation, or excretion that causes persistent or intermittent jaundice, such as Gilbert, Crigler–Najjar, Dubin–Johnson, or Rotor syndrome.

### **Hermanski-Pudlak Syndrome**

A group of inherited disorders involving abnormal lysosome-related organelles, typically causing oculocutaneous albinism, platelet-storage-pool deficiency with bleeding, and sometimes lung or bowel disease.

### **Heroin**

Heroin is a highly addictive opioid converted to morphine in the body; overdose causes respiratory depression, coma, and death, while repeated use causes dependence and withdrawal.

### **Heroin Dependence**

Heroin dependence is opioid-use disorder involving compulsive use, tolerance, and withdrawal; treatment combines overdose prevention, naloxone access, and medicines such as methadone or buprenorphine with psychosocial support.

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## Herpes Labialis

Recurrent blisters or erosions on or around the lips caused most often by herpes simplex virus type 1; tingling is commonly followed by clustered vesicles that crust and heal.

## Herpesviridae

herpesviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Herpesviridae Infection

herpesviridae infection is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Herpesvirus Saimiri

herpesvirus saimiri is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Hesperidin

A flavanone glycoside found mainly in citrus fruits and studied for antioxidant, vascular, and anti-inflammatory effects; clinical benefits and supplement dosing are not established by the term alone.

## Heterochromatin

A clinical condition or finding involving heterochromatin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heterocyclic Amine

A clinical condition or finding involving heterocyclic amine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heterocyclic Compound

A clinical condition or finding involving heterocyclic compound. Its defining features, causes, evaluation,

and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heteroduplex Analysis

A molecular method that compares paired DNA strands containing a sequence mismatch, allowing some mutations or genetic variants to be detected by altered migration or enzyme sensitivity.

## Heterogeneity

Variation in composition, structure, or behavior within a tissue, sample, lesion, or population; in tumors, heterogeneity can affect biopsy interpretation and treatment response.

## Heterogeneous Echotexture

A mixed ultrasound appearance with regions of differing echogenicity, suggesting nonuniform tissue composition from inflammation, fibrosis, fat, hemorrhage, tumor, or other structural change.

## Heterophile Antibody

heterophile antibody concerns heterophile antibody, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Heterophyes Heterophyes

A biomedical term referring to heterophyes Heterophyes; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Heterosexuality

A clinical condition or finding involving heterosexuality. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heterozygote

A heterozygote has two different alleles at a genetic locus, one inherited from each parent; phenotype depends on dominance, the variant's effect, and the surrounding genetic and environmental context.

## Hexachlorobenzene

A clinical condition or finding involving hexachlorobenzene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical

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context.

### **Hexachlorophene**

A clinical condition or finding involving hexachlorophene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hexadecadienoic Acid**

A long-chain fatty acid containing 16 carbon atoms and two double bonds, occurring in lipid metabolism and studied as a biochemical or signaling molecule.

### **Hexadecatetraenoic Acid**

A 16-carbon polyunsaturated fatty acid containing four double bonds, present in lipid pathways and investigated for effects on membranes and signaling.

### **Hexadecatrienoic Acid**

A 16-carbon fatty acid with three double bonds, found in lipid metabolism and plant or animal tissues depending on its isomer.

### **Hexamethonium Compounds**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hexamethonium compounds. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Hexanoic Acid**

A six-carbon saturated fatty acid, also called caproic acid, found in some fats and odors and used in chemical synthesis; concentrated exposure irritates skin and mucosa.

### **Hexestrol**

A clinical condition or finding involving hexestrol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hexose**

A clinical condition or finding involving hexose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hexylresorcinol**

A clinical condition or finding involving hexylresorcinol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hibernation**

A prolonged state of markedly reduced metabolism, body temperature, heart rate, and activity used by some animals to survive cold or food scarcity; medically, the term may describe induced metabolic suppression.

### **Hibernoma**

A rare benign tumor of brown fat, usually a slow-growing painless soft-tissue mass that may feel warm because of its high metabolic and vascular activity.

### **Hiccup**

An involuntary, repeated contraction of the diaphragm followed by sudden closure of the glottis, producing the characteristic sound; persistent hiccups may signal irritation, metabolic disease, or neurologic illness.

### **Hidrocystoma**

A benign cyst of a sweat gland near the eyelid or skin, appearing as a small translucent or bluish papule that may enlarge with heat or sweating.

### **High-Pitched Cry**

An unusually shrill infant cry that can occur with pain, neurologic dysfunction, drug withdrawal, or serious illness and warrants assessment when persistent or accompanied by abnormal behavior or feeding.

### **Hilar**

Relating to a hilum, the gateway where vessels, nerves, ducts, or bronchi enter or leave an organ, especially the lung or kidney.

### **Hind**

Hind means toward the back or rear of an organism or structure, especially in comparative anatomy.

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## Hip

hip refers to hip, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

## Hip Circumference

Hip circumference is the measurement around the widest part of the hips and buttocks, used in body-composition and health-risk assessment.

## Hip Injury

Damage involving the hip joint, surrounding muscles, tendons, ligaments, or bones; causes range from strain and bursitis to fracture and dislocation, with inability to bear weight requiring prompt assessment.

## Hirudin

A potent anticoagulant peptide originally identified in medicinal leech saliva that directly inhibits thrombin and prevents conversion of fibrinogen to fibrin.

## Hirudins

A family of thrombin-inhibiting anticoagulant peptides, including natural and recombinant agents, used or studied to prevent or treat clotting in selected clinical situations.

## Hirudo Medicinalis

A biomedical term referring to *hirudo Medicinalis*; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Histamine Degradation

The enzymatic breakdown of histamine, mainly through diamine oxidase and histamine N-methyltransferase, limiting its effects in the gut, airway, skin, and nervous system.

## Histamine Receptor

A cell-surface receptor activated by histamine; H1, H2, H3, and H4 receptors mediate different effects involving allergy, gastric acid, neurotransmission, and immune-cell activity.

## Histamine Release

Discharge of histamine from mast cells or basophils during allergic, immune, or nonimmune activation, causing effects such as itching, vasodilation, swelling, mucus production, and bronchoconstriction.

## Histidine

Histidine is an amino acid used in protein synthesis and a precursor of histamine; it is essential during growth and can be metabolized to urocanic acid and other products.

## Histidine Decarboxylase

A medicine or chemical compound called histidine decarboxylase. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Histidinemia

An inherited metabolic disorder caused by reduced histidase activity, leading to elevated histidine in blood and urine; many affected people have few or no clinically important symptoms.

## Histiocytic Sarcoma

A neoplastic process affecting histiocytic sarcoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

## Histiocytoma

A tumor or tumor-like proliferation of histiocytes; the term may refer to a benign fibrous skin lesion or, less commonly, a malignant histiocytic neoplasm depending on classification.

## Histocompatibility

Degree of immunological similarity between donor and recipient tissues; determined primarily by HLA antigen matching, critical for transplant success. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

## Histocompatibility Testing

Laboratory typing of HLA and other immune markers to assess donor–recipient compatibility before



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transplantation and to investigate selected immune or transfusion-related questions.

### **Histogenesis**

The developmental process by which unspecialized cells differentiate and organize into mature tissues with characteristic structures and functions.

### **Histological Techniques**

Laboratory methods for preparing, staining, sectioning, and examining tissue under a microscope to reveal cellular architecture, deposits, organisms, or disease-related changes.

### **Histology Cassette**

A labeled perforated container that holds a tissue specimen during processing, allowing fixation, dehydration, paraffin infiltration, and later embedding for microscopic sectioning.

### **Histone**

A histone is a basic DNA-binding protein around which DNA winds to form nucleosomes; histone modifications regulate chromatin accessibility and gene expression.

### **Histone Acetylation**

Addition of acetyl groups to histone proteins that usually loosens DNA packaging and can increase access of transcriptional machinery to genes.

### **Histone Acetyltransferase**

A clinical condition or finding involving histone acetyltransferase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Histone Deacetylases**

A clinical condition or finding involving histone deacetylases. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Histone Deacetylation**

Removal of acetyl groups from histones, often tight-

ening chromatin and reducing transcription; histone deacetylases are targets of some anticancer drugs.

### **Histone Modification**

A chemical change to histone proteins, such as acetylation, methylation, phosphorylation, or ubiquitination, that alters chromatin structure and gene expression.

### **Histopathologic Grade**

A microscopic estimate of how abnormal and aggressive tumor cells appear compared with their tissue of origin; grade contributes to prognosis and treatment planning alongside stage.

### **Histophilus**

A biomedical term referring to histophilus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Histoplasma**

A biomedical term referring to histoplasma; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Hiv Antibodies**

Antibodies produced after exposure to HIV and detected by screening or confirmatory tests; results are interpreted with antigen testing, nucleic-acid testing, timing, and clinical context.

### **Hiv Seropositivity**

The presence of detectable antibodies or other serologic evidence of HIV infection; a reactive screening result requires the recommended confirmatory testing algorithm.

### **Hla Antigen**

A cell-surface human leukocyte antigen encoded by the major histocompatibility complex that presents peptides to T cells and influences transplant compatibility and immune disease risk.

### **Hmgb Proteins**

High-mobility group box proteins that bind and

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bend DNA in the nucleus and can act as inflammatory danger signals when released from damaged or activated cells.

### **Hmgn Proteins**

High-mobility-group nucleosome-binding proteins that regulate chromatin accessibility and influence transcription, DNA repair, and cell differentiation.

### **Holdemia**

A biomedical term referring to holdemia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Holdemia Filiformis**

A biomedical term referring to holdemia filiformis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Holography**

A method of recording and reconstructing the wavefront of light to produce a three-dimensional image; medical applications include experimental imaging, microscopy, and visualization.

### **Holorachischisis**

A severe neural-tube defect in which the spinal cord and vertebral canal fail to close along an extensive length of the spine, usually causing major neurologic impairment.

### **Holter Electrocardiography**

Continuous ambulatory ECG recording, usually for 24 hours or longer, used to detect intermittent arrhythmias, correlate symptoms with rhythm, and assess heart-rate patterns.

### **Homeobox Gene**

A gene containing a homeobox sequence that encodes a DNA-binding homeodomain and helps control embryonic patterning, organ development, and cell identity.

### **Homeodomain Proteins**

Transcription factors containing a homeodomain that bind regulatory DNA sequences and direct developmental patterning and cell differentiation.

### **Homeopathy**

An alternative-health system that uses highly diluted preparations selected according to “like cures like”; reliable evidence has not shown homeopathic products to treat serious disease beyond placebo effects.

### **Homicide**

The killing of one person by another, classified legally according to intent and circumstances; medical assessment may address injury patterns, cause of death, toxicology, and safeguarding.

### **Homo Sapiens**

A biomedical term referring to homo Sapiens; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

### **Homologous Recombination**

A DNA-repair and genetic-exchange process that uses a matching or nearly matching sequence as a template to repair breaks or reshuffle genetic material.

### **Homologous Transplantation**

Transplantation of cells, tissue, or an organ between genetically different people of the same species, requiring attention to compatibility, rejection, infection, and immunosuppression.

### **Homosexuality**

Sexual or romantic attraction to people of the same sex or gender; it is not a mental disorder or pathology.

### **Homovanillic Acid**

A breakdown product of dopamine found in cerebrospinal fluid, blood, and urine; levels may reflect dopamine metabolism but are interpreted cautiously because many factors affect them.

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### **Homozygote**

An individual or cell carrying two identical alleles at a particular gene locus, whether the alleles are normal, pathogenic, or another variant.

### **Hoof Wall**

The hard keratinized outer covering of a hoof that bears weight and protects the deeper tissues; disease or cracking can impair movement and cause pain in hoofed animals.

### **Hordeolum**

A tender, localized infection or inflammation of an eyelid gland, commonly called a sty, producing a painful red lump near the eyelid margin.

### **Hormone Inhibitor**

A medicine or biologic that blocks hormone synthesis, release, receptor binding, or downstream signaling, used in selected endocrine disorders and hormone-sensitive cancers.

### **Hormone Receptor**

A protein that binds a specific hormone and converts the signal into cellular responses, either at the cell surface or inside the cell nucleus.

### **Horseradish Peroxidase**

An enzyme widely used as a laboratory reporter because it catalyzes color-producing or light-producing reactions when supplied with an appropriate substrate.

### **Hospice Care**

Team-based care for a person nearing the end of life that prioritizes comfort, symptom control, communication, and family support rather than disease-directed cure.

### **Hospital**

A biomedical term referring to hospital; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

### **Hospitalization**

Admission to a hospital for monitoring, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, rehabilitation, or intensive support that cannot safely be delivered in an outpatient setting.

### **Host Cell**

A cell in which an infectious agent, parasite, or symbiont lives, replicates, or uses cellular machinery; the host-cell response influences disease and clearance.

### **Hostility**

An attitude or behavior marked by antagonism, anger, distrust, or intent to oppose another person; persistent severe hostility may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, substance-related, or situational problems.

### **Hounsfield Unit**

A CT attenuation value that expresses tissue density relative to water, conventionally assigning air about -1000 HU, water 0 HU, and dense bone positive values.

### **Hour**

A unit of time equal to 60 minutes, commonly used in medicine to describe symptom duration, dosing intervals, monitoring periods, and treatment timing.

### **Human Calcitonin**

A peptide hormone produced by thyroid parafollicular cells that can lower blood calcium by inhibiting osteoclast activity; synthetic calcitonin is used selectively for bone and calcium disorders.

### **Human Embryo**

The developing human organism from fertilization through approximately the eighth week, during which the major body plan and organ systems are established.

### **Human Gastrin**

A peptide hormone produced mainly by gastric G cells that stimulates gastric acid secretion and sup-

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ports growth of the gastric mucosa after food enters the stomach.

### **Human Genome**

The complete DNA sequence and genetic content of a human, organized into nuclear chromosomes and mitochondrial DNA; variants influence traits, disease risk, and treatment response.

### **Human Herpesvirus 6**

human herpesvirus 6 is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Human Herpesvirus 8**

human herpesvirus 8 is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Human Metapneumovirus**

human metapneumovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Human Nociceptin**

A neuropeptide that binds the nociceptin/orphanin FQ receptor and modulates pain, stress, reward, autonomic function, and other brain and spinal-cord processes.

### **Humeral Epicondyle**

A humeral epicondyle is a bony prominence at the lower end of the upper-arm bone where forearm muscles and ligaments attach.

### **Humeral Fracture**

A break in the upper-arm bone, involving the proximal, shaft, or distal humerus; pain, swelling, deformity, and possible nerve or blood-vessel injury

guide urgent assessment and treatment.

### **Humidity**

The amount of water vapor in air, influencing heat loss, respiratory comfort, skin hydration, and survival or transmission of some microorganisms.

### **Hurthle Cell**

A thyroid follicular cell with abundant granular mitochondria-rich cytoplasm, seen in Hashimoto thyroiditis and Hürthle-cell neoplasms.

### **Hyaline**

A clinical condition or finding involving hyaline. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hyaloid Canal**

The hyaloid canal is a narrow channel through the vitreous body of the eye that carried the fetal hyaloid artery and may persist as a remnant.

### **Hyaluronoglucosaminidase**

A clinical condition or finding involving hyaluronoglucosaminidase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hybridoma**

A clinical condition or finding involving hybridoma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hycanthone**

An older antiparasitic drug formerly used against schistosomiasis; its use was abandoned or restricted because of serious toxicity, including liver injury and carcinogenic concern.

### **Hydralazine**

Hydralazine is a direct arteriolar vasodilator used for selected hypertension, including severe hypertension in pregnancy; reflex tachycardia, fluid retention, headache, and drug-induced lupus are recognized adverse effects.

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### Hydrarthrosis

Abnormal accumulation of clear synovial fluid within a joint, producing swelling and restricted movement; causes include osteoarthritis, inflammatory arthritis, trauma, and infection.

### Hydration

The body's water balance and the process of replacing water and electrolytes lost through urine, stool, sweat, breathing, vomiting, or bleeding.

### Hydrazine

A highly reactive chemical used in fuels and industry that can cause irritant, neurologic, hepatic, and systemic toxicity after significant exposure.

### Hydrazine Sulfate

A hydrazine-containing chemical once promoted experimentally for cancer-related symptoms; evidence of benefit is inadequate and toxicity can include liver injury, neuropathy, and seizures.

### Hydrazines

A family of nitrogen-containing chemical compounds used in industry, agriculture, and pharmaceuticals; some are irritants, toxic, mutagenic, or hepatotoxic.

### Hydrazones

Chemical compounds formed by reaction of hydrazine derivatives with aldehydes or ketones, important in medicinal chemistry, analytical chemistry, and some drug structures.

### Hydroa Vacciniforme

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroa vacciniforme. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydrobiology

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrobiology. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydrocarbon

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrocar-

bon. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydrocephalus Acquired

Acquired hydrocephalus is abnormal accumulation of cerebrospinal fluid after birth due to obstruction, impaired absorption, or rarely excess production; raised intracranial pressure may cause headache, vomiting, gait or cognitive change, and visual symptoms.

### Hydrochlorothiazide

Hydrochlorothiazide is a thiazide diuretic that inhibits sodium-chloride reabsorption in the distal convoluted tubule and treats hypertension and mild oedema; hypokalaemia, hyponatraemia, hyperuricaemia, and photosensitivity may occur.

### Hydrocodone

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrocodone. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydrocodone Bitartrate

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrocodone bitartrate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydroflumethiazide

A medicine or chemical compound called hydroflumethiazide. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### Hydrogen

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrogen. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydrogen Cyanide

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrogen cyanide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## Hydrogen Peroxide

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrogen peroxide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydrogen Sulfide

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrogen sulfide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydrogenase

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrogenase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydrogen-Ion Concentration

The concentration of hydrogen ions in a solution, expressed through pH and central to acid-base physiology, enzyme activity, and interpretation of blood-gas results.

## Hydrolase

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrolase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydrolysis

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrolysis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydrolyzable Tannin

A clinical condition or finding involving hydrolyzable tannin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydromorphone

Hydromorphone is a potent opioid analgesic for severe pain; sedation, constipation, respiratory depression, tolerance, and dependence are important risks, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

## Hydromyelia

A clinical condition or finding involving hydromyelia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

agement depend on the clinical context.

## Hydroxamic Acid

An organic functional group containing hydroxylamine attached to a carbonyl, found in chelators and some medicines, including histone-deacetylase inhibitors.

## Hydroxybenzoate

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxybenzoate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydroxychloroquine

Hydroxychloroquine is an antimalarial and immunomodulatory drug used for malaria prevention or treatment and selected autoimmune diseases; cumulative retinal toxicity requires ophthalmic monitoring.

## Hydroxycholesterols

A medicine or chemical compound called hydroxycholesterols. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Hydroxyl Group

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxyl group. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydroxyl Radical

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxyl radical. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydroxylamines

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxylamines. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hydroxylation

An enzymatic or chemical reaction that adds a hydroxyl group to a molecule, often altering the activity, solubility, metabolism, or excretion of a drug or



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biomolecule.

### Hydroxyproline

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxyproline. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydroxyprolinemia

A rare inherited metabolic finding caused by impaired hydroxyproline breakdown, leading to elevated hydroxyproline in blood or urine and usually little clinical illness.

### Hydroxysteroid

A clinical condition or finding involving hydroxysteroid. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hydroxyurea

Hydroxyurea inhibits ribonucleotide reductase and reduces DNA synthesis; it is used for myeloproliferative disorders and to increase fetal haemoglobin in sickle-cell disease, with myelosuppression and other toxicities requiring monitoring.

### Hydroxyzine

Hydroxyzine is a sedating H1-antihistamine used for itching, anxiety, and preoperative sedation; drowsiness, anticholinergic effects, and QT prolongation can occur.

### Hydrozoa

Hydrozoa is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### Hygiene

A clinical condition or finding involving hygiene. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hymenolepiasis

Intestinal infection with dwarf tapeworms, especially *Hymenolepis nana*, acquired by ingesting eggs; it

may cause abdominal symptoms, diarrhea, or be asymptomatic.

### Hymenolepis Diminuta

*hymenolepis diminuta* is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### Hymenolepis Nana

*hymenolepis nana* is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### Hymenoptera

A biomedical term referring to hymenoptera; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Hyoscyamine

A clinical condition or finding involving hyoscyamine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hyperactivity

Excessive or developmentally inappropriate motor activity, restlessness, or difficulty remaining still; persistent impairment may occur in ADHD, mania, substance effects, or other conditions.

### Hyperamylasemia

An elevated blood amylase concentration caused by pancreatic or salivary-gland disease, reduced clearance, macroamylasemia, or other conditions; it is not diagnostic of pancreatitis by itself.

### Hyperargininemia

An inherited urea-cycle disorder caused by arginase deficiency, leading to high arginine and progressive spasticity, developmental impairment, seizures, or liver-related findings.

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### Hyperbaric Chamber

A pressurized chamber in which a person breathes oxygen or another gas at pressure above sea level, used for conditions such as decompression sickness, air embolism, and selected wounds.

### Hyperbilirubinemia

An abnormally high concentration of bilirubin in blood that may cause jaundice; causes include hemolysis, impaired liver processing, hepatocellular injury, and bile-duct obstruction.

### Hypercalciuria

Excessive urinary calcium excretion, which can promote calcium kidney stones and, in some settings, bone mineral loss; evaluation considers diet, medications, kidney function, and endocrine causes.

### Hypercementosis

Excessive deposition of cementum around a tooth root, producing a bulbous root contour that can complicate extraction but is often asymptomatic.

### Hyperemia

Increased blood flow to a tissue, causing redness and warmth; it may be an active physiologic response to exercise or inflammation or a reactive response after temporary ischemia.

### Hyperemia Grade

A graded clinical or endoscopic estimate of tissue redness and vascular congestion, used to describe the severity of inflammation or mucosal irritation.

### Hyperextension

Movement that extends a joint beyond its usual neutral or anatomical range, potentially stretching or tearing ligaments, capsules, muscles, or nerves.

### Hyperfibrinogenemia

An abnormally high blood fibrinogen concentration, commonly reflecting inflammation, infection, pregnancy, obesity, or estrogen exposure and contributing to a prothrombotic state.

### Hyperflexion

Excessive bending of a joint beyond its normal range, which can injure ligaments, discs, muscles, or other supporting structures.

### Hypergammaglobulinemia

An excess of gamma globulins, usually immunoglobulins, in blood caused by polyclonal immune activation or a monoclonal plasma-cell or B-cell disorder.

### Hyperglycinemia

An abnormally high glycine concentration in blood, most notably in nonketotic hyperglycinemia, a disorder of glycine cleavage that can cause neonatal hypotonia, seizures, and developmental impairment.

### Hyperhomocysteinemia

An elevated blood homocysteine concentration associated with genetic enzyme defects, folate or vitamin B12 deficiency, kidney disease, medicines, and increased vascular or pregnancy-related risk in selected settings.

### Hypericum Perforatum

St. John's wort, a plant used in some complementary products for depressive symptoms; it can cause drug interactions by inducing hepatic enzymes and transporters and should not be combined casually with medicines.

### Hyperinsulinism

A clinical condition or finding involving hyperinsulinism. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hyperkeratosis

Thickening of the outer keratin layer of skin or mucosa, producing callus, scale, or rough plaques in response to friction, inflammation, infection, inherited disorders, or other causes.

### Hyperkinesia

Excessive or involuntary movement, such as chorea, dystonia, tics, or tremor, resulting from abnormal activity in motor-control circuits or from drugs and

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other diseases.

### **Hyperlipasaemia**

An abnormally high blood lipase concentration, often associated with pancreatic inflammation but also seen with kidney failure, gastrointestinal disease, medications, and other conditions.

### **Hyperlipoproteinemia**

An excess of one or more lipoproteins in blood, producing high cholesterol or triglycerides and increasing risk of atherosclerosis, pancreatitis, or inherited lipid disease.

### **Hyperlordosis**

Exaggerated inward curvature of the lumbar spine, often producing a swayback appearance and sometimes associated with pain, muscular imbalance, obesity, pregnancy, or structural spinal disease.

### **Hyperlysinemia**

An inherited metabolic abnormality with elevated lysine in blood caused by altered lysine degradation; many people have few symptoms, but some have developmental or neurologic findings.

### **Hypernatremia Result**

A high blood sodium result, usually reflecting too little free water relative to body sodium; severity and rate of onset determine neurologic risk and the urgency and speed of correction.

### **Hyperornithinemia**

An elevated blood ornithine concentration caused by defects in ornithine metabolism or transport, including disorders that can produce retinal degeneration or neurologic disease.

### **Hyperostosis**

Abnormal excessive formation or thickening of bone, which may be localized or widespread and may occur in skeletal dysplasias, inflammation, endocrine disease, or medication effects.

### **Hyperoxaluria**

Excess oxalate production or absorption leading to high urinary oxalate, calcium oxalate stones, nephrocalcinosis, and in severe inherited forms progressive kidney injury.

### **Hyperoxia**

Exposure to an abnormally high oxygen concentration or tissue oxygen level, which can cause oxygen toxicity, absorption atelectasis, retinal injury in premature infants, or lung injury depending on dose and duration.

### **Hyperparakeratosis**

Excessive retention of nuclei in the outer keratin layer of skin or mucosa, producing thickened scale and commonly reflecting inflammation, irritation, or a keratinization disorder.

### **Hyperpituitarism**

Excess production of one or more pituitary hormones, most often from a pituitary adenoma, causing disorders such as acromegaly, Cushing disease, hyperprolactinemia, or precocious puberty.

### **Hyperproteinemia**

An abnormally high total blood-protein concentration, usually from dehydration, chronic inflammation, or a monoclonal immunoglobulin disorder.

### **Hyperpyrexia**

An extreme elevation of body temperature, generally above 41.5 °C, that can result from severe infection, heatstroke, malignant hyperthermia, drug toxicity, or other life-threatening conditions.

### **Hypersplenism**

Cytopenia caused by splenomegaly-related sequestration and increased destruction of circulating blood cells. It may affect red cells, white cells, platelets, or all three, with compensatory bone-marrow activity and an underlying liver, blood, infectious, or infiltrative disorder often present.

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## Hyperthyroxinemia

An abnormally high concentration of circulating thyroxine, caused by hyperthyroidism, thyroiditis, medication, binding-protein changes, or assay interference; symptoms and TSH clarify the cause.

## Hypertonia

Abnormally increased muscle tone or resistance to passive movement, occurring with upper motor-neuron disease, dystonia, cerebral palsy, spinal injury, or other neurologic disorders.

## Hypertrophic Gastritis

Thickening of the gastric mucosal folds caused by glandular overgrowth or inflammation, as in Ménétrier disease; protein loss, pain, nausea, and increased cancer risk may occur.

## Hypertrophic Myocardopathy

Abnormal thickening of the heart muscle, usually the left ventricle, that can impair relaxation, obstruct outflow, cause arrhythmias, and increase sudden-death risk; it is often inherited.

## Hypertropia

Vertical misalignment of the eyes in which one eye deviates upward relative to the other, causing double vision, eye strain, or abnormal head posture.

## Hypervigilance

A state of excessive alertness to possible threat, often accompanied by scanning, startle, irritability, and sleep difficulty in anxiety, trauma-related disorders, stimulant use, or medical illness.

## Hypervolemia

Excess circulating blood or extracellular fluid volume, producing edema, weight gain, breathlessness, elevated venous pressure, or hypertension in settings such as heart, kidney, or liver failure.

## Hypha

A branching tubular filament that forms the basic structural unit of most molds and many fungi; networks of hyphae form a mycelium and may invade

tissue in fungal disease.

## Hypnic Headache

A rare primary headache that repeatedly awakens a person during sleep, usually in later life and often at a similar time each night.

## Hypnotherapy

hypnotherapy is used in relation to hypnotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Hypoadrenalism

Insufficient adrenal-cortex hormone production, especially cortisol and sometimes aldosterone; primary disease can cause fatigue, weight loss, low blood pressure, hyperpigmentation, and adrenal crisis.

## Hypoalbuminemia

An abnormally low blood albumin concentration caused by reduced production, inflammation, kidney or gastrointestinal loss, or severe malnutrition; it can contribute to edema and alter drug binding.

## Hypoalphalipoproteinemias

Disorders with low HDL-related apolipoprotein levels, which may impair reverse cholesterol transport and increase cardiovascular risk depending on the cause and overall lipid profile.

## Hypoblast

The inner cell layer of the early embryonic disc that contributes to the yolk-sac lining and helps establish the embryonic body axes during gastrulation.

## Hypocapnia

An abnormally low arterial carbon-dioxide tension, usually from excessive ventilation due to anxiety, pain, hypoxia, lung disease, pregnancy, or mechanical ventilation.

## Hypocholesterolemia

An unusually low blood cholesterol concentration caused by malnutrition, malabsorption, hyperthyroidism, chronic illness, liver disease, or inherited

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lipid disorders.

### **Hypochromia**

Reduced hemoglobin color in red blood cells, seen as increased central pallor on a blood smear and commonly associated with iron deficiency or thalassemia.

### **Hypochromic Anemia**

Anemia in which red cells contain too little hemoglobin and appear pale, most often because of iron deficiency, thalassemia, chronic disease, or sideroblastic disorders.

### **Hypocitraturia**

Low urinary citrate excretion, which reduces inhibition of calcium-crystal formation and increases risk of calcium kidney stones; potassium citrate may be used when clinically appropriate.

### **Hypocupremia**

An abnormally low copper concentration in blood or tissues, caused by inadequate intake, malabsorption, excess zinc, or inherited disorders, and potentially producing anemia, neutropenia, or neurologic disease.

### **Hypodermic Needle**

A hollow needle designed to inject medicines or withdraw fluid through the skin, with gauge and length selected according to the substance, route, body site, and patient.

### **Hypogalactia**

Insufficient breast-milk production for an infant's needs, caused by ineffective milk removal, hormonal or breast disorders, medications, illness, or other feeding difficulties.

### **Hypoglossal Nerve**

Cranial nerve XII, which supplies the muscles that move the tongue; a lesion causes tongue weakness, wasting, and deviation toward the affected side on protrusion.

### **Hypoglycemic Agent**

A medicine that lowers blood glucose, including insulin, insulin secretagogues, insulin sensitizers, incretin-based drugs, and sodium-glucose cotransporter inhibitors; choice depends on diabetes type and patient risks.

### **Hypokinesia**

Reduced amplitude or amount of voluntary movement, commonly seen in Parkinson disease and other basal-ganglia disorders; it may appear as a short-stepped gait, reduced facial expression, or small handwriting.

### **Hypolipidemic Agents**

Medicines that lower cholesterol or triglycerides, including statins, ezetimibe, fibrates, bile-acid sequestrants, niacin, and selected injectable therapies.

### **Hypolipoproteinemia**

An abnormally low concentration of one or more blood lipoproteins, caused by inherited disorders, malabsorption, malnutrition, liver disease, or other systemic illness.

### **Hypomethylation**

Reduced addition of methyl groups to DNA or other molecules, which can alter gene expression, genomic stability, imprinting, and cancer biology.

### **Hypopharyngeal Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting hypopharyngeal neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Hypophosphatemic Ricket**

Rickets caused by low phosphate availability, often from renal phosphate wasting, leading to defective mineralization, bowed legs, bone pain, growth impairment, and dental abnormalities.

### **Hypophysectomy**

hypophysectomy is used in relation to hypophysectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

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### **Hypophysitis**

Inflammation of the pituitary gland that can cause headache, visual symptoms, and deficiency or excess of pituitary hormones; it may be autoimmune, related to pregnancy, or triggered by immune-checkpoint therapy.

### **Hypoploidy**

A chromosome number below the normal diploid complement, caused by loss of one or more chromosomes; in tumor cytogenetics it may have prognostic significance.

### **Hypothalamic Hamartoma**

A congenital, noncancerous mass of disorganized hypothalamic tissue that can cause gelastic seizures, precocious puberty, behavioral symptoms, or cognitive decline.

### **Hypothalamic Hormone**

A releasing or inhibiting hormone produced by the hypothalamus that regulates pituitary secretion, including signals controlling thyroid, adrenal, reproductive, growth, and lactation axes.

### **Hypothalamic Neoplasm**

A neoplastic process affecting hypothalamic neoplasm; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, biologic behavior, and appropriate management.

### **Hypotrichosis**

Abnormally sparse or absent hair caused by inherited follicle disorders, autoimmune disease, endocrine or nutritional problems, medications, or scarring alopecia.

### **Hypotropia**

Vertical eye misalignment in which one eye deviates downward relative to the other, potentially causing diplopia, abnormal head posture, or suppression of vision.

### **Hypoxanthine**

A naturally occurring purine base and intermediate in purine metabolism that is converted to xanthine

by xanthine oxidase and can be salvaged to form inosine monophosphate.

### **Hysteroscope**

A thin camera-equipped instrument passed through the cervix to inspect the uterine cavity and, when designed for operative use, remove polyps, treat bleeding, or perform other procedures.

### **High Hemoglobin Count**

A hemoglobin level above the expected range, which may reflect dehydration, chronic low oxygen, smoking, medication effects, or a blood disorder.

### **High Blood Protein**

An abnormally increased concentration of proteins in the blood, which may result from dehydration, inflammation, infection, or a plasma-cell disorder.

### **High Potassium (Hyperkalemia)**

An abnormally high potassium level in the blood that can affect muscle and heart function and may result from kidney disease, medicines, tissue injury, or other conditions.

### **High Uric Acid Level**

An increased concentration of uric acid in the blood, which may contribute to gout or kidney stones and can result from reduced kidney clearance, diet, medicines, or metabolic disease.

### **High White Blood Cell Count**

An increased number of white blood cells, often associated with infection, inflammation, stress, medicines, or a blood or bone marrow disorder.

### **Hip Pain**

A clinical condition involving hip Pain; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **H1N1 Influenza (Swine Flu)**

H1N1 influenza is a strain of influenza A virus that causes an acute respiratory illness with fever, cough, myalgia, and variable pulmonary complications.



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## H2 Blockers

H2 blockers reduce gastric acid secretion by antagonizing histamine H2 receptors on parietal cells and are used for reflux, dyspepsia, ulcers, and selected hypersecretory states.

## H2 Receptor Antagonists Overdose

H2 receptor antagonists overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to h2 receptor antagonists overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Haemophilus Influenzae Type B (Hib) Vaccine - What You Need To Know

A biomedical term referring to haemophilus Influenzae Type B (Hib) Vaccine - What You Need To Know; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Hair Bleach Poisoning

Hair bleach poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hair bleach poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Hair Dye Poisoning

Hair dye poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hair dye poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Hair Spray Poisoning

Hair spray poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hair spray poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Hair Straightener Poisoning

Hair straightener poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hair straightener poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Hair Tonic Poisoning

Hair tonic poisoning involves toxic or environmental

exposure to hair tonic poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Hair Transplant

A procedure that moves hair follicles, usually from a donor area of the scalp, to areas affected by permanent hair loss; results depend on diagnosis, donor supply, technique, and postoperative care.

## Hallucinations

Hallucinations are perceptions without an external sensory stimulus and can arise from psychiatric illness, neurologic disease, delirium, substances, medications, sensory loss, or sleep transitions.

## Halo Brace - Aftercare

Care after halo-brace placement includes pin-site cleaning, skin checks, alignment and neurologic monitoring, pain control, and instructions to report loosening, drainage, fever, or worsening neck symptoms.

## Halo Brace - Child

A clinical condition or finding involving halo brace - child. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Hammer Toe Repair

Surgery to correct a fixed or painful flexion deformity of a lesser toe, using soft-tissue release, tendon balancing, bone correction, or temporary fixation as indicated.

## Hammer Toe Repair - Discharge

Postoperative instructions after hammer-toe surgery covering dressing and wound care, protected weight bearing, footwear, swelling control, exercises, follow-up, and warning signs of infection or circulation problems.

## Hamstring Strain - Aftercare

Recovery care for a hamstring muscle injury, progressing from protection and symptom control to gentle range-of-motion, strengthening, and graded return to running or sport.

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### **Hand Fracture - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning hand fracture - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Hand Lotion Poisoning**

Hand lotion poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hand lotion poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Hand Or Foot Spasms**

Hand or foot spasms concerns hand or foot spasms, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Hand X-Ray**

A clinical condition or finding involving hand x-ray. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Handling Sharps And Needles**

Handling sharps and needles concerns handling sharps and needles, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Handwashing**

Handwashing concerns handwashing, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Hangover Treatment**

Supportive care for alcohol-related next-day symptoms such as headache, nausea, thirst, fatigue, and poor concentration; hydration, rest, and time help, while more alcohol or unsafe medication combinations can worsen harm.

### **Haptoglobin Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess haptoglobin blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Hardware Removal - Extremity**

Surgical removal of plates, screws, rods, or other orthopedic hardware from an arm or leg when it causes pain, infection, prominence, nonunion-related problems, or other selected complications.

### **Hartnup Disorder**

A clinical condition involving hartnup Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Hazardous Materials**

Substances that can cause injury, poisoning, fire, radiation exposure, or environmental harm; safe handling requires labeling, protective equipment, exposure control, and emergency procedures.

### **HCG Blood Test - Qualitative**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hcg blood test - qualitative. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **HCG Blood Test - Quantitative**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hcg blood test - quantitative. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **HCG In Urine**

A clinical condition or finding involving hcg in urine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **HDL Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hdl test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Head And Face Reconstruction**

A clinical condition or finding involving head and face reconstruction. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## Head CT Scan

A clinical condition or finding involving head ct scan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Head Injury - First Aid

A clinical condition involving head Injury - First Aid; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Head MRI

A clinical condition or finding involving head mri. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Headache - What To Ask Your Doctor

A patient-care topic concerning headache - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Headaches - Danger Signs

Headaches - danger signs concerns headaches - danger signs, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Health Care Agents

A patient-care topic concerning health care agents. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Risks Of Alcohol Use

A biomedical term referring to health Risks Of Alcohol Use; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## Health Risks Of Obesity

Obesity increases the risk of type 2 diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, sleep apnea, fatty liver disease, osteoarthritis, some cancers, and pregnancy complications.

## Health Screenings For Men Age 65 And

## Older

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for men age 65 and older. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Screenings For Men Ages 18 To 39

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for men ages 18 to 39. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Screenings For Men Ages 40 To 64

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for men ages 40 to 64. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Screenings For Women Age 65 And Older

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for women age 65 and older. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Screenings For Women Ages 18 To 39

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for women ages 18 to 39. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Health Screenings For Women Ages 40 To 64

A patient-care topic concerning health screenings for women ages 40 to 64. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Healthy Food Trends - Beans And Legumes

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - beans and legumes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Healthy Food Trends - Brussels Sprouts

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - brussels sprouts. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Healthy Food Trends - Chia Seeds**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - chia seeds. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Food Trends - Flaxseeds**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - flaxseeds. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Food Trends - Kale**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - kale. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Food Trends - Microgreens**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - microgreens. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Food Trends - Quinoa**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy food trends - quinoa. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Grocery Shopping**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy grocery shopping. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Habits For Weight Loss**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy habits for weight loss. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Healthy Living**

A clinical condition or finding involving healthy living. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and

management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hearing Loss - Infants**

Hearing loss - infants concerns hearing loss - infants, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Hearing Loss And Music**

Hearing loss and music concerns hearing loss and music, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Hearing Or Speech Impairment - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning hearing or speech impairment - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Heart And Vascular Services**

Heart and vascular services concerns heart and vascular services, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Heart Attack - Discharge**

Home-care guidance after myocardial infarction, including prescribed antiplatelet and cardiac medicines, activity progression, cardiac rehabilitation, risk-factor control, and urgent evaluation of recurrent chest symptoms.

### **Heart Attack - What To Ask Your Provider**

Heart attack - what to ask your provider concerns heart attack - what to ask your provider, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Heart Attack First Aid**

Heart attack first aid concerns heart attack first aid, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and

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patient context.

### **Heart Bypass Surgery**

Coronary artery bypass grafting creates new routes around blocked coronary arteries using graft vessels to improve myocardial blood flow and relieve ischemic symptoms or reduce selected risks.

### **Heart Bypass Surgery - Discharge**

Recovery instructions after coronary bypass surgery covering incision care, activity limits, breathing exercises, medicines, cardiac rehabilitation, follow-up, and warning signs such as infection or recurrent ischemia.

### **Heart Bypass Surgery - Minimally Invasive**

Coronary bypass performed through smaller chest incisions or with limited access rather than a full sternotomy; suitability depends on coronary anatomy, surgeon expertise, and patient factors.

### **Heart Bypass Surgery - Minimally Invasive - Discharge**

Post-discharge care after minimally invasive coronary bypass, including wound monitoring, gradual activity, pain control, medication adherence, rehabilitation, and symptoms requiring urgent review.

### **Heart CT Scan**

A clinical condition or finding involving heart ct scan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Heart Disease - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning heart disease - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Heart Disease - Risk Factors**

A clinical condition or finding involving heart disease - risk factors. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Heart Disease And Depression**

A clinical condition involving heart Disease And Depression; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Heart Disease And Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning heart disease and diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Heart Disease And Intimacy**

A clinical condition involving heart Disease And Intimacy; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Heart Disease And Women**

A clinical condition involving heart Disease And Women; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Heart Failure - Discharge**

Home-care guidance for heart failure, including daily weight and symptom monitoring, sodium and fluid advice when prescribed, medication adherence, follow-up, and action for rapid weight gain or worsening breathlessness.

### **Heart Failure - Fluids And Diuretics**

Fluid and diuretic management in heart failure aims to reduce congestion while avoiding dehydration, kidney injury, electrolyte abnormalities, and low blood pressure.

### **Heart Failure - Medicines**

Heart-failure medicines may reduce fluid overload, blood pressure, harmful remodeling, heart rate, or clot risk; selection depends on ejection fraction, kidney function, rhythm, and symptoms.

### **Heart Failure - Palliative Care**

A patient-care topic concerning heart failure - palliative care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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## Heart Failure - Surgeries And Devices

Heart-failure surgery and devices include revascularization, valve procedures, ventricular support, pacemakers, defibrillators, and transplantation for selected patients.

## Heart Failure - Tests

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess heart failure - tests. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## Heart Failure - What To Ask Your Doctor

A patient-care topic concerning heart failure - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Heart Failure In Children

Heart failure in children is inability of the heart to meet body demands, caused by congenital defects, cardiomyopathy, rhythm disease, infection, or other illness.

## Heart Failure In Children - Home Care

A patient-care topic concerning heart failure in children - home care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## Heart MRI

A clinical condition or finding involving heart mri. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heart Murmurs

Heart murmurs concerns heart murmurs, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Heart Pacemaker

Heart pacemaker concerns heart pacemaker, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Heart Pacemaker - Discharge

Instructions after pacemaker implantation covering incision care, arm and activity precautions, device identification, follow-up checks, and urgent symptoms such as fainting, chest pain, fever, or lead displacement.

## Heart PET Scan

A clinical condition or finding involving heart pet scan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Heart Transplant

Replacement of a failing heart with a donor heart, followed by lifelong immunosuppression and surveillance for rejection, infection, coronary allograft disease, kidney injury, and medication complications.

## Heart Valve Surgery

Repair or replacement of a diseased cardiac valve to correct severe narrowing or leakage and improve blood flow; choice of repair, mechanical valve, or tissue valve depends on anatomy and patient factors.

## Heart Valve Surgery - Discharge

Recovery instructions after valve surgery covering incision care, anticoagulation when indicated, activity and rehabilitation, dental and infection precautions, follow-up imaging, and warning signs.

## Heartburn - What To Ask Your Provider

Heartburn - what to ask your provider concerns heartburn - what to ask your provider, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Heat Emergencies

Heat emergencies range from heat cramps and exhaustion to heat stroke, in which dangerous core-temperature elevation causes central nervous system dysfunction and organ injury.

## Heel Pain And Achilles Tendonitis - Aftercare

Rehabilitation for heel or Achilles-tendon pain uses



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load modification, supportive footwear, stretching, and progressive calf strengthening; persistent or sudden severe pain requires reassessment for rupture or another cause.

### **Heimlich Maneuver On Self**

A clinical condition or finding involving heimlich maneuver on self. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Help Prevent Hospital Errors**

A biomedical term referring to help Prevent Hospital Errors; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

### **Helping A Loved One With A Drinking Problem**

Support for someone with alcohol use disorder includes calm nonjudgmental communication, boundaries, encouragement toward medical treatment, attention to withdrawal risk, and emergency action for overdose or dangerous withdrawal.

### **Helping Your Child Understand A Cancer Diagnosis**

A neoplastic condition involving helping Your Child Understand A Cancer Diagnosis; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Helping Your Teen With Depression**

Support for an adolescent with depression includes listening without judgment, arranging professional assessment, supporting treatment and routines, reducing access to lethal means, and acting urgently for self-harm risk.

### **Hemodialysis Access - Self Care**

Daily care of an arteriovenous fistula, graft, or catheter preserves blood flow and prevents infection; check for a thrill, avoid compression, and report redness, drainage, swelling, or loss of flow.

### **Hemodialysis Access Procedures**

Procedures that create, maintain, repair, or revise vascular access for hemodialysis, including fistula or graft creation, catheter placement, angioplasty, thrombectomy, and treatment of stenosis or infection.

### **Hemoglobinuria Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hemoglobinuria test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Hemolytic Anemia Caused By Chemicals And Toxins**

Toxic hemolytic anemia occurs when chemicals or medicines damage red blood cells, causing anemia, jaundice, dark urine, weakness, and sometimes kidney injury.

### **Hemolytic Crisis**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemolytic crisis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemolytic Transfusion Reaction**

A medical procedure involving hemolytic transfusion reaction. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Hemophilia - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning hemophilia - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Hemorrhoid Removal - Discharge**

Postoperative care after hemorrhoid removal includes pain control, stool-softening measures, hygiene, hydration, activity guidance, expected bleeding, and urgent review for heavy bleeding, fever, or urinary retention.

### **Hemorrhoid Surgery**

An operation to remove or reduce symptomatic internal or external hemorrhoids when bleeding, prolapse, thrombosis, or pain persists despite appropriate con-

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servative treatment.

### **Hemorrhoids**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemorrhoids. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hemovac Drain**

A clinical condition or finding involving hemovac drain. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hepatic Vein Obstruction (Budd-Chiari)**

A biological or anatomical term referring to hepatic vein obstruction (budd-chiari). Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Hepatitis A - Children**

Hepatitis A in children is acute liver infection spread mainly by fecal contamination and usually resolves, though dehydration or severe liver injury can occur.

### **Hepatitis A Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

Hepatitis A vaccine safely induces protection against hepatitis A and is recommended according to age, risk, travel, and local immunization schedules.

### **Hepatitis B - Children**

Hepatitis B in children is infection with hepatitis B virus, which may be acute or chronic and can cause liver inflammation, cirrhosis, or cancer.

### **Hepatitis B Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

Hepatitis B vaccine prevents infection and its chronic complications and is routinely given beginning at birth, with additional doses according to schedule.

### **Hepatitis C - Children**

Hepatitis C in children is infection with hepatitis C virus, often acquired around birth or through blood exposure and now frequently curable with direct-acting antivirals.

### **Hepatitis D (Delta Agent)**

Hepatitis D is infection with a virus that requires hepatitis B to replicate and can make hepatitis B liver disease more severe.

### **Hepatitis Virus Panel**

A hepatitis virus panel is a group of blood tests identifying antibodies, antigens, or nucleic acids associated with hepatitis A, B, C, or other viral hepatitis.

### **Hepatocerebral Degeneration**

A biological substance or process involving hepatocerebral Degeneration; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Herbal Remedies And Supplements For Weight Loss**

Plant-based weight-loss products have variable evidence, uncertain composition, and potential stimulant, liver, cardiovascular, or drug-interaction risks; they should not replace evidence-based obesity treatment.

### **Hereditary Amyloidosis**

Hereditary amyloidosis is an inherited disorder in which variant proteins misfold and deposit as amyloid in nerves, heart, kidneys, liver, or other organs.

### **Hereditary Fructose Intolerance**

A clinical condition or finding involving hereditary fructose intolerance. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hereditary Ovalocytosis**

Hereditary ovalocytosis is an inherited red-cell membrane disorder causing oval-shaped erythrocytes and usually mild or variable hemolytic anemia.

### **Hereditary Spherocytic Anemia**

Hereditary spherocytic anemia, or hereditary spherocytosis, is an inherited red-cell membrane disorder causing spherical cells, hemolysis, jaundice, and

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sometimes enlarged spleen.

### **Hereditary Urea Cycle Abnormality**

An inherited defect in ammonia disposal that can cause neonatal or episodic hyperammonemia, vomiting, lethargy, seizures, coma, and neurologic injury; acute decompensation requires urgent metabolic treatment.

### **Heroin Overdose**

Heroin overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to heroin overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Herpes - Oral**

Oral herpes is usually caused by herpes simplex virus type 1 and produces recurrent grouped blisters or ulcers around the lips or mouth, with asymptomatic viral shedding.

### **Herpes - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning herpes - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Herpes Viral Culture Of Lesion**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess herpes viral culture of lesion. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Herpetic Stomatitis**

Herpetic stomatitis is painful infection of the mouth and gums caused by herpes simplex virus, often with blisters, ulcers, fever, and swollen gums.

### **Heterochromia**

A clinical condition or finding involving heterochromia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **High Blood Cholesterol Levels**

Excess circulating cholesterol, especially LDL cholesterol, promotes atherosclerotic plaque and increases

risk of coronary disease and stroke; assessment includes overall cardiovascular risk and treatment response.

### **High Blood Pressure - Medicine-Related**

Hypertension caused or worsened by a medicine or substance, such as NSAIDs, steroids, decongestants, stimulants, oral contraceptives, or immunosuppressants; review and substitution may improve control.

### **High Blood Pressure - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient-care topic concerning high blood pressure - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **High Blood Pressure And Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning high blood pressure and diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **High Blood Pressure And Eye Disease**

A clinical condition involving high Blood Pressure And Eye Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **High Blood Pressure In Adults - Hypertension**

Adult hypertension is persistently elevated arterial blood pressure that increases risk of stroke, heart disease, kidney disease, and other complications.

### **High Blood Pressure In Children - Hypertension**

Childhood hypertension is blood pressure persistently above age-, sex-, and height-based thresholds and may reflect obesity, kidney disease, endocrine illness, or medications.

### **High Blood Pressure In Infants - Hypertension**

Infant hypertension is elevated blood pressure in a baby and may result from kidney, vascular, heart, lung, endocrine, medication, or intensive-care conditions.

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### **High Blood Pressure Medications**

Medicines used to lower arterial blood pressure, including diuretics, ACE inhibitors, ARBs, calcium-channel blockers, beta blockers, and other agents selected according to comorbidities and risk.

### **High Blood Sugar - Self-Care**

Self-management of hyperglycemia includes glucose monitoring, prescribed medicines or insulin, hydration, meal planning, sick-day rules, and urgent assessment for vomiting, dehydration, confusion, or ketones.

### **High Cholesterol - Children**

Elevated cholesterol in a child may reflect inherited familial hypercholesterolemia, diet, obesity, endocrine disease, or medication; confirmation and family assessment guide lifestyle and specialist treatment.

### **High Potassium Level**

Hyperkalemia is an elevated blood potassium concentration that can cause dangerous cardiac conduction abnormalities; confirmation, medication review, kidney assessment, ECG, and urgent treatment depend on level and symptoms.

### **High-Fiber Foods**

Foods rich in soluble or insoluble dietary fiber, including legumes, whole grains, vegetables, fruit, nuts, and seeds, support bowel regularity and may improve cholesterol and glucose control when increased with adequate fluid.

### **Hip Arthroscopy**

A clinical condition or finding involving hip arthroscopy. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hip Flexor Strain - Aftercare**

Recovery after a hip-flexor muscle strain uses relative rest, pain control, gradual stretching, progressive strengthening, and staged return to activity while avoiding sudden sprinting or forceful hip flexion.

### **Hip Fracture - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning hip fracture - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Hip Fracture Surgery**

A medical procedure involving hip fracture surgery. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Hip Joint Injection**

A medical procedure involving hip joint injection. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Hip Joint Replacement**

Arthroplasty replaces damaged parts of the hip with prosthetic components to relieve pain and improve mobility, commonly for advanced osteoarthritis, fracture, or other destructive joint disease.

### **Hip Or Knee Replacement - After - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A medical procedure involving hip or knee replacement - after - what to ask your doctor. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Hip Or Knee Replacement - Before - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A medical procedure involving hip or knee replacement - before - what to ask your doctor. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Hip Or Knee Replacement - In The Hospital After**

Immediate postoperative care after hip or knee arthroplasty includes pain control, blood-clot prevention, wound monitoring, early mobilization, exercises, and assessment for infection, dislocation, or neurovascular problems.

### **Hip Replacement - Discharge**

Home instructions after hip arthroplasty cover

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wound care, walking aids, exercises, clot prevention, precautions against dislocation, pain medicines, follow-up, and symptoms requiring urgent review.

### **His Bundle Electrography**

A clinical condition or finding involving his bundle electrography. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Histocompatibility Antigen Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess histocompatibility antigen test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Histoplasma Complement Fixation**

A blood test that detects complement-fixing antibodies to Histoplasma and can support evaluation of histoplasmosis, although sensitivity, timing, cross-reactions, and immune status affect interpretation.

### **Histoplasma Skin Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess histoplasma skin test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Histoplasmosis - Acute (Primary) Pulmonary**

A biomedical term referring to histoplasmosis - acute (primary) pulmonary; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **HIV/AIDS - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning hiv/aids - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **HIV/AIDS In Pregnant Women And Infants**

HIV care in pregnancy and infancy uses maternal antiretroviral therapy, viral-load monitoring, delivery and feeding planning, infant prophylaxis, and early infant diagnostic testing to reduce vertical

transmission.

### **HLA-B27 Antigen**

A cell-surface immune marker associated with increased risk of ankylosing spondylitis and related spondyloarthritis, reactive arthritis, and uveitis; a positive result is not diagnostic by itself.

### **Hodgkin Lymphoma In Children**

Childhood Hodgkin lymphoma is a cancer of lymphoid tissue, often presenting with painless nodes, fever, night sweats, or weight loss and treated with risk-adapted therapy.

### **Holter Monitor (24H)**

A clinical condition or finding involving holter monitor (24h). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hormonal Effects In Newborns**

A clinical condition or finding involving hormonal effects in newborns. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hormone Levels**

A biological or anatomical term referring to hormone levels. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Hormone Therapy For Breast Cancer**

A biological or anatomical term referring to hormone therapy for breast cancer. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Hormone Therapy For Prostate Cancer**

A biological or anatomical term referring to hormone therapy for prostate cancer. Its role depends on the relevant tissue, function, and clinical context.

### **Hospitals As Health Educators**

A biomedical term referring to hospitals As Health Educators; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

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### Hot Tub Folliculitis

Hot-tub folliculitis is an itchy or tender follicle infection caused by *Pseudomonas* after exposure to contaminated warm water and usually resolves with supportive care.

### Household Glue Poisoning

Household glue poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to household glue poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### HPV (Human Papillomavirus) Vaccine - What You Need To Know

A medicine or chemical compound called hpv (human papillomavirus) vaccine - what you need to know. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### HPV Test

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess hpv test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### Human Bites - Self-Care

Human bites - self-care involves toxic or environmental exposure to human bites - self-care; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Human Metapneumovirus (HMPV)

A medicine or chemical compound called human metapneumovirus (hmpv). Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### Humidifiers And Health

A biomedical term referring to humidifiers And Health; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

### Hump On Upper Back (Dorsocervical Fat

### Pad)

A visible accumulation of fat at the back of the neck and upper shoulders, associated with obesity, corticosteroid excess, some medicines, or lipodystrophy; it differs from spinal kyphosis.

### Hydramnios

Excess amniotic fluid during pregnancy, also called polyhydramnios, caused by fetal swallowing impairment, maternal diabetes, multiple gestation, fetal anomalies, infection, or sometimes no identifiable cause.

### Hydrocarbon Pneumonia

A clinical condition involving hydrocarbon Pneumonia; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### Hydrocele Repair

Surgery to close or remove the fluid-containing sac around a testicle when a hydrocele is persistent, large, painful, associated with a hernia, or obscures examination.

### Hydrochloric Acid Poisoning

Hydrochloric acid poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydrochloric acid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hydrocodone And Acetaminophen Overdose

Hydrocodone and acetaminophen overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydrocodone and acetaminophen overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hydrocodone/Oxycodone Overdose

Hydrocodone/oxycodone overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydrocodone/oxycodone overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.



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### Hydrofluoric Acid Poisoning

Hydrofluoric acid poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydrofluoric acid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hydrogen Peroxide Poisoning

Hydrogen peroxide poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydrogen peroxide poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hydromorphone Overdose

Hydromorphone overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydromorphone overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hydronephrosis Of One Kidney

Unilateral hydronephrosis is dilation of one kidney's urine-collecting system from obstruction or reflux and can damage kidney function if persistent.

### Hydroxyzine Overdose

Hydroxyzine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to hydroxyzine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Hyperactivity And Children

A clinical condition or finding involving hyperactivity and children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hyperactivity And Sugar

A clinical condition or finding involving hyperactivity and sugar. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Hypercalcemia - Discharge

Home-care instructions after treatment for high blood calcium include hydration and prescribed medicines, follow-up laboratory testing, and urgent

attention to confusion, weakness, vomiting, dehydration, or rhythm symptoms.

### Hyperelastic Skin

Hyperelastic skin stretches farther than usual and may reflect inherited connective-tissue disorders such as Ehlers-Danlos syndrome or a benign variant.

### Hyperglycemia - Infants

Hyperglycemia in an infant is abnormally high blood glucose caused by prematurity, illness, stress, medicines, nutrition, or rare endocrine or genetic disorders.

### Hyperimmunization

Hyperimmunization is an unusually strong or repeated immune exposure, sometimes referring to an over-vaccinated state or production of high-titer antibodies.

### Hyperimmunoglobulin E Syndrome

A clinical condition involving hyperimmunoglobulin E Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### Hyperkalemic Periodic Paralysis

Hyperkalemic periodic paralysis is an inherited channel disorder causing brief attacks of muscle weakness associated with elevated or shifting potassium.

### Hypermobile Joints

A clinical disorder related to hypermobile joints; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### Hypersensitivity Vasculitis

A clinical disorder related to hypersensitivity vasculitis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### Hyperthermia For Treating Cancer

A clinical disorder related to hyperthermia for treating cancer; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

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### **Hypervitaminosis A**

A clinical disorder related to hypervitaminosis a; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypervitaminosis D**

A clinical disorder related to hypervitaminosis d; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypokalemic Periodic Paralysis**

A clinical disorder related to hypokalemic periodic paralysis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypomelanosis Of Ito**

A clinical disorder related to hypomelanosis of ito; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypospadias Repair**

Surgery reconstructs the urethral opening and, when needed, straightens the penis in a child born with hypospadias; timing and technique depend on anatomy and surgeon assessment.

### **Hypospadias Repair - Discharge**

Postoperative care after hypospadias repair covers catheter and dressing care, medicines, bathing and activity restrictions, follow-up, and warning signs such as fever, bleeding, wound separation, or poor urine flow.

### **Hypothalamic Dysfunction**

A clinical condition or finding involving hypothalamic dysfunction. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hypothalamic Tumor**

A clinical disorder related to hypothalamic tumor; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hysterectomy - Abdominal - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning hysterectomy - abdominal - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Hysterectomy - Laparoscopic - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning hysterectomy - laparoscopic - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Hysterectomy - Vaginal - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning hysterectomy - vaginal - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Heart Attack Prevention**

Heart-attack prevention targets blood pressure, atherogenic cholesterol, diabetes, tobacco exposure, diet, physical activity, weight, sleep, and adherence to prescribed medicines. Risk-based preventive treatment is more effective than relying on one supplement or symptom.

### **Hiatal Hernia Overview**

A hiatal hernia occurs when part of the stomach moves through the diaphragm into the chest. It may cause reflux, chest or upper-abdominal discomfort, swallowing problems, or no symptoms; treatment ranges from lifestyle and acid control to surgery.

### **High Blood Pressure Hypertension**

Hypertension is persistently elevated arterial pressure that increases the risk of stroke, heart disease, kidney disease, eye damage, and dementia. Diagnosis uses repeated accurate measurements, and management combines lifestyle measures with medicines when indicated.

### **High White Blood Cell Count In Pregnancy**

A mild rise in white blood cells can be normal during pregnancy, labor, or stress. Marked or persistent elevation with fever, pain, urinary or respiratory symptoms, or abnormal differential counts may indicate infection, inflammation, medication effect, or another disorder.

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## Hip Bursitis

Hip bursitis is inflammation of a bursa near the hip, commonly causing pain over the outer hip that worsens with lying on that side, stairs, or prolonged walking. Activity changes, physical therapy, medicines, or injection may help after other causes are considered.

### Synonyms:

Trochanteric Bursitis (Hip Bursitis)

## Hodgkin's And Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma Comparison

Hodgkin lymphoma is defined by characteristic Reed-Sternberg cells and commonly spreads in an orderly pattern, while non-Hodgkin lymphomas comprise many B-cell, T-cell, and other lymphoid cancers. Biopsy, immunophenotyping, and staging determine treatment and prognosis.

## Hypoxia And Hypoxemia

Hypoxemia is low oxygen in arterial blood, while hypoxia is inadequate oxygen at the tissue level. Causes include lung disease, airway obstruction, heart disease, anemia, shock, or high altitude; severe breathlessness, cyanosis, confusion, or collapse is urgent.

## H And H

Abbreviation for hemoglobin and hematocrit, two blood measurements commonly used to assess red-blood-cell levels and anemia.

## H And P

Abbreviation for history and physical examination, the clinical history and examination performed to assess a patient.

## HAART

Abbreviation for highly active antiretroviral therapy, an older term for combination antiretroviral treatment used to suppress HIV replication and preserve immune function.

## Habitus

A person's general body build, physical appearance,

or constitutional type as observed clinically.

## Hair, Lanugal

Lanugo: the fine, soft, usually unpigmented hair covering a fetus and sometimes present on a premature newborn; it is normally shed before or shortly after birth.

## Hand-Arm Vibration Syndrome

An occupational disorder from prolonged exposure to vibrating tools, causing numbness, tingling, reduced grip, and episodic whitening of the fingers from vascular spasm.

## Hangover

A group of symptoms after alcohol use, such as headache, nausea, thirst, fatigue, dizziness, and sensitivity to light; symptoms reflect effects of alcohol and its metabolites, dehydration, sleep disruption, and inflammation.

## HAPE

Abbreviation for high-altitude pulmonary edema, a life-threatening accumulation of fluid in the lungs after rapid ascent; immediate descent and supplemental oxygen are urgent treatments.

## Haploinsufficiency

A genetic state in which one functional copy of a gene does not produce enough gene product for normal function, so loss or inactivation of the other copy can cause disease.

## HAV

Abbreviation for hepatitis A virus, an RNA virus spread mainly by the fecal-oral route that causes acute hepatitis but usually does not cause chronic infection.

## Hb (Hemoglobin)

Hemoglobin, the iron-containing protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen and contributes to carbon-dioxide transport and blood's acid-base buffering.

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## HBV

Abbreviation for hepatitis B virus, a DNA virus transmitted through infected blood or body fluids that can cause acute or chronic hepatitis and cirrhosis or liver cancer.

## Hct (Hematocrit)

The percentage of blood volume occupied by red blood cells, measured as part of a complete blood count.

## HCV PCR

A polymerase chain reaction test that detects or measures hepatitis C virus RNA in blood, helping identify active infection and monitor treatment response.

## HDL Cholesterol

Cholesterol carried in high-density lipoprotein particles; HDL participates in transporting cholesterol from tissues toward the liver, but its concentration alone does not determine cardiovascular risk.

## HDR Syndrome

A genetic disorder characterized by hypoparathyroidism, sensorineural deafness, and renal dysplasia or other kidney abnormalities, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *GATA3*.

## Health For All

A public-health goal emphasizing that all people should have access to needed health services and conditions that support health, without financial hardship.

## Health Risk

The likelihood that a behavior, exposure, condition, or other factor will cause harm to health, considered together with the severity and timing of possible harm.

## Heart Muscle

The myocardium, the specialized cardiac muscle that contracts rhythmically to pump blood through the heart and circulation.

## Heart Rhythm Disorders

Arrhythmias, in which the heart beats too fast, too slowly, or irregularly because of abnormal electrical impulse formation or conduction.

### Synonyms:

Abnormal Heart Rhythms (Heart Rhythm Disorders)

## Heart Test, EPS

An electrophysiology study of the heart, using catheters to record and stimulate cardiac electrical activity and evaluate arrhythmias, conduction disorders, or unexplained fainting.

## Heat Prostration

An older term for severe heat exhaustion, marked by weakness, fatigue, dizziness, headache, nausea, and sweating after heat exposure; confusion or loss of consciousness suggests heat stroke.

## Heat Rash (Pictures)

Miliaria, an itchy or prickly rash caused by blocked sweat ducts and trapped sweat, usually in hot humid conditions.

## Hecht's Pneumonia

A rare, often fatal giant-cell pneumonia associated with measles, especially in immunocompromised children, characterized by multinucleated giant cells in the lung alveoli.

## Hedonophobia

An excessive or persistent fear of pleasure or pleasurable experiences that causes significant distress or avoidance.

## Hejama

An Arabic term for cupping, a traditional practice in which suction is applied to the skin; wet cupping also involves superficial skin incisions and carries bleeding and infection risks.

## Hematology-Oncology

The medical specialty concerned with blood disorders and cancers, including anemia, leukemia, lym-

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phoma, myeloma, and clotting disorders.

### **Hematophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of blood, blood-related sights, or medical procedures involving blood that causes distress or avoidance; some people have a vasovagal fainting response.

### **Hemi-**

A prefix meaning half or one side, as in hemiplegia and hemithorax.

### **Hemidiaphragm**

One of the two muscular halves of the diaphragm separating the chest from the abdomen and assisting breathing.

### **Hemithorax**

One side of the thorax, including the lung, pleural space, ribs, and other structures on that side of the chest.

### **Hemizygous**

Having only one copy of a gene or chromosome region rather than the usual pair, as occurs for many X-linked genes in people with one X chromosome.

### **Hemoglobin Normal Values**

Reference ranges for blood hemoglobin concentration, which vary with age, sex, pregnancy, altitude, laboratory method, and other factors; results should be interpreted using the reporting laboratory's range.

### **Hemolytic**

Relating to hemolysis, the premature destruction of red blood cells, which can release hemoglobin and produce anemia or jaundice.

### **Hemolytic Jaundice, Congenital**

Jaundice present from or caused by an inherited condition that increases red-blood-cell destruction, producing excess unconjugated bilirubin; examples include hereditary spherocytosis and some enzymatic defects.

### **Hemophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of blood, also called hematophobia, that causes significant distress, avoidance, or sometimes a vasovagal faint.

### **HEPA**

Abbreviation for high-efficiency particulate air, describing a filter designed to remove a very high proportion of airborne particles of specified sizes from an air stream.

### **Hepar**

Latin for liver; it is used in medical terminology and in names of substances or preparations relating to the liver.

### **Hepat-**

A combining form meaning liver, as in hepatic and hepatocellular.

### **Hepatic Biopsy**

Removal of a small sample of liver tissue for microscopic or molecular examination, often to evaluate inflammation, fibrosis, fatty liver disease, infection, or an abnormal mass.

### **Hepatic Duct**

The duct formed by the union of the right and left liver ducts, carrying bile from the liver toward the common bile duct and intestine.

### **Hepatic Steatosis**

Excess accumulation of fat in liver cells, commonly called fatty liver; causes include metabolic disease, alcohol, medicines, and other conditions, and inflammation or fibrosis may develop in some people.

### **Hepatitis F**

A historical or proposed label for an additional hepatitis virus; no distinct, confirmed human hepatitis F virus is currently recognized as an established cause of hepatitis.

### **Hepato-**

A combining form meaning liver, as in hepatobiliary

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and hepatomegaly.

### **Hepatobiliary**

Relating to the liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts.

### **Hepatology**

The medical specialty concerned with the liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, and related diseases.

### **HER2**

Human epidermal growth factor receptor 2, also called ERBB2, a cell-surface receptor whose increased expression or gene amplification drives some cancers and may guide targeted treatment.

### **Herniation**

Protrusion of an organ, tissue, or structure through an abnormal opening or weak area, as in a herniated disk or abdominal-wall hernia.

### **Herpes Simplex Type 1**

HSV-1, a DNA virus commonly causing oral or perioral blisters; it can also cause genital infection and remains latent with possible recurrence.

### **Hetero-**

A prefix meaning different, other, or unequal, as in heterozygous and heterogeneous.

### **Heterotopic**

Located in an abnormal or unusual place; a heterotopic pregnancy is simultaneous implantation outside the uterus and, usually, inside the uterus.

### **Hexadactyly**

The presence of six fingers or six toes on a hand or foot, also called polydactyly.

### **Hg**

The chemical symbol for mercury; in measurements such as mmHg, it refers to millimeters of mercury, a unit of pressure.

### **HGD**

Commonly an abbreviation for high-grade dysplasia,

a marked abnormality of cell development that may be a precursor to invasive cancer but is not itself invasive cancer.

### **Hiatal**

Relating to a hiatus, an opening or passage in an anatomical structure; a hiatal hernia occurs when abdominal tissue passes through the diaphragm's esophageal hiatus.

### **Hiatus**

An opening, gap, or passage in an anatomical structure, such as the esophageal hiatus in the diaphragm.

### **Hiccough**

Another term for hiccup, a sudden involuntary contraction of the diaphragm followed by rapid closure of the vocal cords that produces a characteristic sound.

### **High Altitude**

Elevation high enough that reduced atmospheric pressure lowers available oxygen, commonly beginning around 2,500 meters and increasing the risk of altitude illness.

### **High Blood Sugar**

Hyperglycemia, an abnormally elevated concentration of glucose in the blood; persistent hyperglycemia is commonly associated with diabetes but can have other causes.

### **High Protein Diet**

An eating pattern providing more protein than a person's usual or estimated requirement; suitability depends on nutritional needs, kidney and liver function, and the overall diet.

### **HIPAA**

The United States Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act, including federal rules governing protected health information, privacy, security, and certain electronic health-care transactions.



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## Hippocrates

An ancient Greek physician traditionally regarded as a major founder of Western clinical medicine; the Hippocratic corpus emphasizes observation, prognosis, and professional conduct.

## Hippocratic Oath

A traditional ethical pledge for physicians, emphasizing duties such as beneficence, confidentiality, and avoidance of harm; modern versions vary by institution and country.

## Hippophobia

An excessive or persistent fear of horses that causes significant distress or avoidance.

## His

Usually referring to the bundle of His, the atrioventricular conduction bundle that carries electrical impulses from the AV node into the right and left bundle branches.

## His Disease

Trench fever, a louse-borne infection caused by *Bartonella quintana*, classically producing recurrent or five-day fever, headache, and severe shin or leg pain.

## Histiocyte

A tissue-resident immune cell of the mononuclear phagocyte system, generally derived from monocytes and capable of engulfing foreign material and presenting antigen.

## Histo-

A combining form meaning tissue, as in histology and histopathology.

## History, Developmental

A record of a child's developmental milestones and abilities, including motor, language, cognitive, social, and adaptive skills, used to identify possible delays or regression.

## History, Social

Information about a person's living situation, re-

lationships, occupation, education, tobacco or substance use, diet, safety, and other social factors relevant to health and care.

## HNP

Abbreviation for herniated nucleus pulposus, in which the inner material of an intervertebral disk protrudes through the outer ring and may compress a nerve root.

## Homeotherm

An organism that maintains a relatively stable internal body temperature despite changes in environmental temperature, largely through physiological regulation.

## Homo-

A prefix meaning same or alike, as in homozygous and homologous.

## Homosexual

Describing a person who experiences enduring romantic or sexual attraction to people of the same sex; sexual orientation is not a mental disorder.

## Horripilation

Piloerection, or the temporary raising of hair and development of gooseflesh due to cold, fear, emotion, or autonomic stimulation.

## Horror Autotoxicus

A historical immunology concept describing the supposed inability of the immune system to attack the body's own tissues; autoimmune disease showed that this idea was not universally correct.

## House Officer

A physician receiving postgraduate clinical training in a hospital, such as an intern, resident, or fellow; usage varies by country and institution.

## House Staff

The physicians and other trainees who provide patient care within a hospital under the supervision of attending clinicians, commonly including interns,

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residents, and fellows.

### House Surgeon

A hospital-based physician, historically a junior surgical trainee or resident responsible for inpatient surgical care; usage varies by institution.

### HPS

Common medical abbreviations include hantavirus pulmonary syndrome, a severe respiratory illness, and Hermansky–Pudlak syndrome, an inherited disorder with oculocutaneous albinism and platelet-storage abnormalities; context determines the meaning.

### HRT (Hormone Replacement Therapy)

Treatment with hormones to replace deficient hormones or relieve symptoms, such as menopausal estrogen therapy; benefits, risks, and the need for a progestogen depend on the indication and patient.

### HS

Commonly an abbreviation for hereditary spherocytosis, an inherited hemolytic anemia; it can also mean half-strength, heart sounds, hamstrings, heparan sulfate, hernia sac, or house surgeon, so context is essential.

### HSA

Abbreviation that may mean a US health savings account or human serum albumin, the main plasma protein that helps maintain oncotic pressure; context determines the meaning.

### Ht

Common abbreviation for hematocrit, the percentage of blood volume occupied by red blood cells; in other contexts it may mean height.

### Human Chromosome Count

Most human body cells contain 46 chromosomes arranged in 23 pairs, including one pair of sex chromosomes; mature egg and sperm cells normally contain 23.

### Humidifier

A device that adds moisture to air; medical humidifiers require appropriate cleaning and water handling because contaminated equipment can disperse infectious or inflammatory material.

### Humidifier Fever

A flu-like illness caused by inhalation of microorganisms or biologic contaminants from a contaminated humidifier or ventilation system, often involving fever, chills, cough, and malaise.

### Humor

In anatomy, a fluid of the body, especially the aqueous or vitreous humor of the eye; in ordinary language, it means a sense of amusement or comedy.

### Humoralism

The historical medical theory that health depended on balance among four bodily fluids, or humors: blood, phlegm, yellow bile, and black bile.

### Humorism

Another name for the ancient theory of humoral balance, which attributed disease to excess or deficiency of blood, phlegm, yellow bile, or black bile.

### Hydrocephalus Ex-Vacuo

Enlargement of the brain's ventricles secondary to loss or shrinkage of surrounding brain tissue, rather than primarily from obstructed cerebrospinal-fluid flow.

### Hydrocephaly

Hydrocephalus: abnormal accumulation or circulation of cerebrospinal fluid that enlarges the ventricles and may increase pressure on the brain.

### Hyper-

A prefix meaning excessive, above normal, or increased, as in hyperglycemia and hypertension.

### Hyperadrenocorticism

Excess production or exposure to adrenal glucocorticoids, especially cortisol; in humans it causes

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Cushing syndrome, which may result from adrenal, pituitary, ectopic, or medication-related causes.

### **Hyperbaric**

Having a pressure greater than the surrounding atmospheric pressure; hyperbaric oxygen therapy delivers oxygen at increased pressure for selected medical indications.

### **Hypergraphia**

Excessive, compulsive, or unusually prolonged writing or drawing, sometimes associated with temporal-lobe epilepsy, mania, or other neurologic or psychiatric conditions.

### **Hypermagnesemia**

An abnormally high concentration of magnesium in the blood, often related to kidney failure or excessive magnesium intake; severe cases can cause weakness, low blood pressure, depressed reflexes, or arrhythmias.

### **Hyperosmolar**

Having a higher concentration of osmotically active particles than a reference fluid; increased plasma osmolality draws water out of cells and can impair neurologic function.

### **Hypertonic Solution**

A solution with greater effective osmotic concentration than the fluid with which it is compared, causing water to move out of cells across a semipermeable membrane.

### **Hypertrophic**

Relating to hypertrophy, an enlargement of cells or tissue that increases the size of an organ or structure.

### **Hypo-**

A prefix meaning below, deficient, reduced, or less than normal, as in hypoglycemia and hypothermia.

### **Hypoglycemic**

Relating to an abnormally low blood glucose level, or describing a medicine that lowers blood glucose.

### **Hypomnesia**

Reduced ability to remember or recall information, which may occur with aging, neurologic disease, psychiatric conditions, medications, or other causes.

### **Hypotensive**

Having or causing abnormally low blood pressure; symptoms may include dizziness, fainting, weakness, confusion, or shock depending on the cause and severity.

### **Hypotonic Solution**

A solution with lower effective osmotic concentration than the fluid with which it is compared, causing water to move into cells across a semipermeable membrane.

### **Hysterosalpingogram (HSG)**

An X-ray study in which contrast material is placed through the cervix to outline the uterine cavity and fallopian tubes, commonly to assess uterine structure and tubal patency during infertility evaluation.

### **Hives And Angioedema**

Hives are raised itchy welts; angioedema is deeper swelling of the skin or mucous membranes, often caused by allergy, medicines, or other immune reactions.

### **Heart Arrhythmia**

An abnormal heart rate or rhythm caused by altered electrical activity in the heart; it may be too fast, too slow, or irregular.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dysrhythmias

### **Hodgkin Lymphoma (Hodgkin Disease)**

A cancer of the lymphatic system characterized by abnormal lymphocytes and often presenting with painless lymph-node enlargement, fever, sweats, or weight loss.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Hodgkin Lymphoma Lymphoma, Hodgkin

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### **Hurthle Cell Cancer**

A rare thyroid cancer arising from Hurthle cells, with behavior ranging from indolent to aggressive.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Hurthle Cell Oxyphil Cell Carcinoma

### **Hashimoto's Disease**

An autoimmune disorder in which the immune system attacks the thyroid, often leading to hypothyroidism.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chronic Lymphocytic Thyroiditis Thyroiditis, Chronic Lymphocytic

### **High Red Blood Cell Count**

An increased number or concentration of red blood cells in the blood, which may thicken the blood and result from dehydration, low oxygen, smoking, medications, or a bone marrow disorder.

#### **Synonyms:**

Polycythemia (High Red Blood Cell Count)

### **H1N1 Flu (Swine Flu)**

Influenza caused by the H1N1 virus strain, spread through respiratory droplets and capable of causing ordinary or severe flu illness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Influenza, H1N1 Influenza, Swine Flu

### **Hepatic Jaundice (Hepatocellular Jaundice)**

Jaundice caused by impaired processing or excretion of bilirubin by damaged liver cells.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hepatocellular Jaundice

### **H And E Staining**

H and E Staining is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Habituation**

Habituation is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare

concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hache's Sign**

Hache's Sign is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Hacking**

A clinical condition or finding involving hacking. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Haem**

A hematologic term related to haem; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematemesis**

A hematologic term related to haematemesis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematin**

A hematologic term related to haematin; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematinics**

A hematologic term related to haematinics; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematite**

A hematologic term related to haematite; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematocele**

A hematologic term related to haematocele; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematocolpos**

A hematologic term related to haematocolpos; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells,

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proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematogenous**

A hematologic term related to haematogenous; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematometra**

A hematologic term related to haematometra; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematomyelia**

A hematologic term related to haematomyelia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematopericardium**

A hematologic term related to haematopericardium; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematopoiesis**

A hematologic term related to haematopoiesis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematoporphyria**

A hematologic term related to haematoporphyria; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haematosalpinx**

A hematologic term related to haematosalpinx; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemochromatosis**

A hematologic term related to haemochromatosis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemoflagellate**

A hematologic term related to haemoflagellate; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells,

proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemoglobin**

A hematologic term related to haemoglobin; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemoglobinopathy**

A hematologic term related to haemoglobinopathy; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemoglobinuria**

A hematologic term related to haemoglobinuria; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemolysis**

A hematologic term related to haemolysis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemolytic Anaemia**

A hematologic term related to haemolytic anaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemoperitoneum**

A hematologic term related to haemoperitoneum; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemophilus**

A hematologic term related to haemophilus; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemorrhage**

British spelling of Hemorrhage; see Hemorrhage.

### **Haemorrhagic Fever**

A hematologic term related to haemorrhagic fever; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

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### **Haemorrhagic Fever With Renal Syndrome**

A hematologic term related to haemorrhagic fever with renal syndrome; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemorrhagic Stroke**

A hematologic term related to haemorrhagic stroke; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemosiderin**

A hematologic term related to haemosiderin; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemosiderosis**

A hematologic term related to haemosiderosis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemostasis**

A hematologic term related to haemostasis; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemostat**

A hematologic term related to haemostat; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haemothorax**

A hematologic term related to haemothorax; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haff Disease**

A clinical disorder related to haff disease; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hageman Factor**

A hematologic term related to hageman factor; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells,

proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hair-Ball**

Hair-Ball is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hair Dye**

Hair Dye is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hairless**

Hairless is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hairy Cell Leukaemia**

Hairy Cell Leukaemia is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hajdu-Cheney Syndrome**

A clinical disorder related to hajdu-cheney syndrome; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hallervorden-Spatz Disease**

A clinical disorder related to hallervorden-spatz disease; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hamamelis**

A clinical condition or finding involving hamamelis. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hamate Bone**

Hamate Bone is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hamburger Phenomenon**

A clinical condition or finding involving hamburger phenomenon. Its defining features, causes, eval-



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uation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hand-Schüller-Christian Disease**

Hand-Schüller-Christian Disease is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hang-Nail**

A clinical condition or finding involving hang-nail. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hansen's Disease**

Another name for leprosy; see Leprosy. It is a chronic infection caused by *Mycobacterium leprae* or *M. lepromatosis* that primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves.

### **Haploid**

Haploid is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hare-Lip**

A clinical condition or finding involving hare-lip. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Harlequin Foetus**

A clinical condition or finding involving harlequin foetus. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Harmless Murmur**

A clinical condition or finding involving harmless murmur. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Harris-Imvoden Equation**

Harris-Imvoden Equation is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Harrison's Sulcus**

Harrison's Sulcus is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Hashimoto's Thyroiditis**

A clinical disorder related to hashimoto's thyroiditis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hashish**

Hashish is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hassall's Corpuscles**

A hematologic term related to hassall's corpuscles; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Haustra**

A clinical condition or finding involving haustra. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Haverhill Fever**

A clinical disorder related to haverhill fever; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hazardous Substance**

Hazardous Substance is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **HCG**

A hematologic term related to hcg; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Head-Lice**

Head-Lice is an anatomical structure, body region,

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tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Healing**

Healing is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Health**

Health is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Health Maintenance Organization**

Health Maintenance Organization is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Health Visitor**

Health Visitor is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Healthy Eating**

Healthy Eating is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Heart-Lung Machine**

Heart-Lung Machine is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Heat**

A clinical condition or finding involving heat. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Heberden's Nodes**

A clinical condition or finding involving heberden's nodes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hebefrenia**

A clinical condition or finding involving hebefrenia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hebetic**

A clinical condition or finding involving hebetic. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Hectocotylyzation**

Hectocotylyzation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Hedonia**

A clinical condition or finding involving hedonia. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Heel**

Heel is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hegar's Sign**

Hegar's Sign is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Hegar's Dilators**

Hegar's Dilators is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Heine-Medin Disease**

A clinical disorder related to heine-medin disease; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Heliotherapy**

Heliotherapy is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose,

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toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Helix**

Helix is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Heller's Operation**

Heller's Operation is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Hemeralopia**

A hematologic term related to hemeralopia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hemiballismus**

A hematologic term related to hemiballismus; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hemispatial Neglect**

A hematologic term related to hemispatial neglect; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hepatic Coma**

A clinical disorder related to hepatic coma; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hepatitis G**

A clinical disorder related to hepatitis g; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Heptachlor**

Heptachlor is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Heredo-Ataxia**

A clinical disorder related to heredo-ataxia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Heredopolyneuritis**

A clinical disorder related to heredopolyneuritis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hering-Breuer Reflex**

Hering-Breuer Reflex is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

### **Hermaphroditism**

A clinical condition or finding involving hermaphroditism. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Herpetiform**

A clinical condition or finding involving herpetiform. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Herxheimer Reaction**

A clinical disorder related to herxheimer reaction; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Heterologous**

Heterologous is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or health-care concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Heterophil Antibody**

Heterophil Antibody is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Heteroplasia**

Heteroplasia is a developmental, immunologic, repro-

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ductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Heterosexual**

Heterosexual is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Heterotransplant**

Heterotransplant is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hexachlorophane**

Hexachlorophane is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hexamethonium**

Hexamethonium is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hexamine**

Hexamine is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hexane**

Hexane is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hexoestrol**

Hexoestrol is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hibernation, Artificial**

Hibernation, Artificial is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Hidrosis**

A biomedical term referring to hidrosis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **High Altitude Illness**

A clinical disorder related to high altitude illness; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **High-Density Lipoprotein (HDL)**

High-Density Lipoprotein (HDL) is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **High-Fructose Corn Syrup**

High-Fructose Corn Syrup is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **High Output Failure**

High Output Failure is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **High Risk**

High Risk is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hill's Sign**

Hill's Sign is a diagnostic test, sign, measurement, reflex, or clinical method used to evaluate a patient; interpretation depends on the method and context.

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## Hilus

Hilus is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

## Hindbrain

Hindbrain is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

## Hindgut

Hindgut is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

## Hippocratic Succussion

Hippocratic Succussion is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

## Hippus

Hippus is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

## Histochemical

A hematologic term related to histochemical; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

## History

History is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

## HLA System

A hematologic term related to hla system; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

## Hofmann's Syndrome

A clinical disorder related to hofmann's syndrome; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

## Holistic Medicine

Holistic Medicine is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

## Holmium

Holmium is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

## Holocaine

Holocaine is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

## Home Care

Home Care is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

## Homeostasis, Psychological

Homeostasis, Psychological is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

## Homograft

Homograft is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

## Homologous

Homologous is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

## Homophile

Homophile is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

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### **Honey-Bee Stings**

Honey-Bee Stings is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hong Kong Flu**

Hong Kong Flu is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Honolulu Fever**

A clinical disorder related to honolulu fever; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hormone Replacement Therapy (HRT)**

Hormone Replacement Therapy (HRT) is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Horn**

Horn is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hornet Stings**

Hornet Stings is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hospitalism**

Hospitalism is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hot Flushes**

Hot Flushes is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Hour-Glass Contraction**

Hour-Glass Contraction is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Housemaid's Knee**

Housemaid's Knee is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **HPylori**

HPylori is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Huber Needle**

Huber Needle is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hunchback**

Hunchback is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Hunter's Syndrome**

A clinical disorder related to hunter's syndrome; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Huntington's Chorea**

A clinical disorder related to huntington's chorea; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hürthle Cell Tumour**

A clinical disorder related to hürthle cell tumour; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hutchinson's Teeth**

Hutchinson's Teeth is an anatomical structure, body



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region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hyalitis**

Hyalitis is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Hyaluronidase**

Hyaluronidase is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hydatid Disease**

Cystic echinococcosis caused by the larval stage of *Echinococcus granulosus* and related species. Humans acquire infection by ingesting eggs shed in dog feces; hydatid cysts develop most often in the liver or lungs and may remain silent or cause pain, obstruction, infection, rupture, or allergic reaction. Diagnosis relies on characteristic imaging with supportive serology, and treatment must be individualized by specialists because unsafe puncture or rupture can cause anaphylaxis and secondary spread.

### **Hydrocortisone**

Hydrocortisone is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hydrocyanic Acid Poisoning**

Hydrocyanic Acid Poisoning is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hydrops**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in tissues or body cavities. The term may refer to generalized fetal edema, a localized collection, or organ-specific fluid distension; the cause depends on the clinical setting.

### **Hygroma**

Hygroma is a developmental, immunologic, reproductive, behavioral, environmental, or healthcare concept used in medicine or biomedical research.

### **Hymenectomy**

Hymenectomy is an anatomical structure, body region, tissue, or physiologic function; its location and role explain its clinical significance.

### **Hydrops Of The Gallbladder**

Distension of the gallbladder by clear mucus or watery fluid, usually caused by prolonged obstruction of the cystic duct by a gallstone. It may cause right-upper-quadrant pain and can progress to inflammation or infection.

### **Hyoscine**

Hyoscine is a medicine, chemical, treatment, device, or exposure; its indication, mechanism, dose, toxicity, and precautions depend on the specific product or circumstance.

### **Hyperaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hyperaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperaesthesia**

A clinical disorder related to hyperaesthesia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperbilirubinaemia**

A hematologic term related to hyperbilirubinaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hypercalcaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypercalcaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypercholesterolaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypercholesterolaemia;

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diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperglycaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hyperglycaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperkalaemia**

British spelling of Hyperkalemia; see Hyperkalemia.

### **Hyperlipidaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hyperlipidaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypermetropia**

A clinical disorder related to hypermetropia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypermotility**

A clinical disorder related to hypermotility; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypernatraemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypernatraemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperosmolar Non-Ketotic Coma**

A clinical disorder related to hyperosmolar non-ketotic coma; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperpathia**

A clinical disorder related to hyperpathia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperpnoea**

A clinical disorder related to hyperpnoea; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypertensive Encephalopathy**

A clinical disorder related to hypertensive encephalopathy; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyperventilating**

A clinical disorder related to hyperventilating; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypervolaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypervolaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypnagogic**

Hypnagogic is a medical or biological term describing a defined process, structure, substance, or clinical finding; its precise meaning depends on context.

### **Hypocalcaemia**

British spelling of Hypocalcemia; see Hypocalcemia.

### **Hypochlorite**

A clinical disorder related to hypochlorite; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypochondriasis**

A clinical disorder related to hypochondriasis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypochromic Anaemia**

A hematologic term related to hypochromic anaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hypoglycaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypoglycaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypokalaemia**

British spelling of Hypokalemia; see Hypokalemia.

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### **Hypomagnesaemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypomagnesaemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hyponatraemia**

A clinical disorder related to hyponatraemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypophosphataemia**

A clinical disorder related to hypophosphataemia; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypophysis**

A clinical disorder related to hypophysis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypoproteinaemia**

A hematologic term related to hypoproteinaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hypothesis**

A clinical disorder related to hypothesis; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypovolaemia**

A hematologic term related to hypovolaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hypoxaemia**

A hematologic term related to hypoxaemia; its significance depends on the relevant blood cells, proteins, pathways, or clinical findings.

### **Hysteria**

A clinical disorder related to hysteria; diagnosis and treatment depend on its cause, characteristic findings, and severity.

### **Hypopigmentation**

Reduced skin pigmentation producing paler areas than the surrounding skin, caused by decreased melanin, reduced melanocyte function or number, inflammation, injury, infection, or inherited disorders.

### **Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza (HPAI)**

Highly pathogenic influenza A infection in birds that can cause severe disease and mortality in poultry; selected strains can rarely infect humans after animal exposure.

### **Hyperimmunoglobulin D Syndrome**

A hereditary autoinflammatory disorder, usually caused by mevalonate kinase deficiency, characterized by recurrent fever, enlarged lymph nodes, abdominal symptoms, rash, and joint or muscle pain; it is also called HIDS or MKD.

### **Hailey-Hailey Disease**

An inherited acantholytic disorder caused by pathogenic variants in *ATP2C1*, producing recurrent erosions and fragile vesicles in flexures such as the neck, axillae, and groins.

### **Hidradenoma**

A usually benign adnexal neoplasm showing differentiation toward sweat-gland epithelium and presenting as a solitary dermal or subcutaneous nodule. It is commonly slow growing and may be flesh colored, erythematous, cystic, or ulcerated, which can make clinical distinction from other skin tumors difficult. Histology typically demonstrates a well-circumscribed proliferation with polygonal or clear cells, ductal structures, and variable cystic change. Excision is generally diagnostic and therapeutic; atypia, infiltrative growth, recurrence, or metastasis raises concern for hidradenocarcinoma or another malignant adnexal tumor.

### **Hidradenocarcinoma**

A rare malignant sweat-gland tumor that may arise de novo or from a hidradenoma, presenting as a firm nodule and capable of local recurrence and

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metastasis.

### **Heart Valve Disease**

Structural or functional abnormality of one or more cardiac valves causing stenosis, regurgitation, or both. Common causes include degeneration, congenital malformation, rheumatic disease, and infective endocarditis.

### **Hidradenoma Papilliferum**

A benign papillary tumor of apocrine or mammary-like glands, usually presenting as a solitary flesh-colored or red nodule in the vulvar or anogenital region.

### **Hyperreactio Luteinalis**

Bilateral ovarian enlargement with multiple theca-lutein cysts caused by an exaggerated response to human chorionic gonadotropin, usually during pregnancy or with trophoblastic disease.

### **Heterotopic Breast Tissue Of The Vulva**

Ectopic mammary-like tissue in the vulva that may undergo benign, hormonal, inflammatory, or malignant changes similar to breast tissue; diagnosis is histologic.

### **Hemosiderotic Synovitis**

Synovial inflammation with hemosiderin deposition caused by recurrent bleeding into a joint, commonly associated with hemophilia, anticoagulation, trauma, or a vascular synovial lesion.

### **High-Grade Surface Osteosarcoma**

A high-grade osteogenic sarcoma arising on the surface of bone, including periosteal or parosteal regions, with aggressive local and metastatic potential.

### **Hospital Medicine**

The medical specialty focused on comprehensive care of hospitalized patients, including diagnosis, treatment, coordination across teams, transitions of care, and prevention of inpatient complications.

### **HIV Transmission And Prevention**

The spread of HIV through infected blood, semen, vaginal fluids, rectal fluids, or breast milk, prevented by testing, treatment that suppresses viral load, condoms, sterile equipment, and pre- or post-exposure prophylaxis.

## I

### **IBD**

Inflammatory bowel disease, including Crohn's disease and ulcerative colitis, causing chronic intestinal inflammation.

**Synonyms:**

Inflammatory bowel disease

### **ICD**

Implantable cardioverter-defibrillator, a device that detects dangerous heart rhythms and delivers a corrective shock.

**Synonyms:**

Implantable cardioverter defibrillator

### **Ice Pick Headache**

A sudden, severe, stabbing headache that usually lasts only seconds.

**Synonyms:**

Primary stabbing headache

### **Iliopsoas Muscles**

The psoas major and iliacus muscles, which work together to flex the hip.

**Synonyms:**

Iliopsoas

### **Immobilize**

To restrict movement of a body part, often with a splint or cast, to support healing.

**Synonyms:**

Immobilization

### **Immunoglobulin E**

An antibody class that plays a central role in many immediate allergic reactions.

**Synonyms:**

IgE

### **Immunologically Privileged Site**

A body site where immune responses are limited to reduce risk of tissue damage.

### **Impacted**

Firmly wedged or unable to move from its normal position, as with an impacted tooth.

### **Impaction**

Obstruction caused by material that is firmly lodged, such as hardened stool in the bowel.

### **Impotence**

An older term for erectile dysfunction.

**Synonyms:**

Erectile dysfunction

### **In Situ**

In its original place or position.

**Synonyms:**

In place

### **Inactivated Vaccines**

Vaccines made from microorganisms that have been killed and cannot reproduce.

### **Inferior Myocardial Infarction**

A heart attack affecting the lower or inferior portion of the heart muscle.

### **Infiltrating Cancer**

Cancer that has grown beyond its site of origin into

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surrounding tissue.

**Synonyms:**

Invasive cancer

**Infusion**

Slow administration of a fluid or medicine into a vein or tissue.

**Synonyms:**

Intravenous infusion

**Inhibitory Neurochemical**

A chemical messenger that reduces signaling between nerve cells.

**Synonyms:**

Inhibitory neurotransmitter

**Injectable Fillers**

Materials injected beneath or into skin to restore volume or soften wrinkles.

**Synonyms:**

Dermal fillers

**Inoperable**

Not suitable for surgical treatment, often because surgery cannot safely remove or correct the condition.

**Insulin**

A pancreatic hormone that helps cells take up glucose and lowers blood glucose.

**Insulin-Dependent Diabetes**

Type 1 diabetes, in which the pancreas produces little or no insulin and replacement insulin is required.

**Synonyms:**

Type 1 diabetes

**Intense Pulsed Light**

Broadband light treatment used for selected cosmetic skin conditions and hair reduction.

**Synonyms:**

IPL

**Intensity**

The degree of effort or physiological demand during physical activity.

**Interferons**

Signaling proteins that help coordinate immune responses, especially against viral infections.

**Interleukins**

Cytokines that carry signals between immune cells and regulate inflammation.

**Synonyms:**

ILs

**Intermediate-Density Lipoprotein**

A lipoprotein remnant formed as very-low-density lipoprotein is metabolized toward LDL.

**Synonyms:**

IDL

**Intervention Study**

A study in which researchers assign or provide an intervention and compare its outcomes with a control.

**Synonyms:**

Clinical trial

**Intervertebral Disk**

A fibrocartilaginous cushion between spinal vertebrae that absorbs shock and permits movement.

**Synonyms:**

Intervertebral disc

**Intervertebral Foramen**

An opening between adjacent vertebrae through which a spinal nerve exits.

**Synonyms:**

Neural foramen

**Intolerance**

An adverse response to a substance that does not involve the immune mechanism of an allergy.

**Synonyms:**

Nonallergic sensitivity Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity



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(Intolerance)

### **Intrinsic Sphincter Deficiency**

Weakness of the urinary sphincter that causes stress urinary incontinence.

**Synonyms:**  
ISD

### **Iodides**

Salts containing iodine, sometimes used in carefully selected thyroid disorders.

### **Irritants**

Substances that provoke inflammation or allergy-like symptoms without necessarily causing an immune allergy.

### **Ischemic Heart Disease**

Heart disease caused by inadequate blood flow through narrowed or blocked coronary arteries.

**Synonyms:**  
Coronary artery disease; coronary heart disease

### **Iatrogenic**

An illness or condition caused by medical examination or treatment. Examples: hospital-acquired infections, drug side effects, surgical complications, radiation-induced damage. Prevention: proper technique, informed consent, monitoring, reporting systems.

### **Iatrogenic Injury**

An injury caused unintentionally by a medical examination, treatment, procedure, or medicine.

### **ICD Shock Therapy**

Anti-tachycardia pacing (ATP) for slow VT delivers rapid pacing pulses to terminate the arrhythmia painlessly. Cardioversion shock synchronously terminates VT. Defibrillation shock treats VFib asynchronously. The MADIT-RIT trial showed that higher-rate programming (detection >180-200 bpm) reduced inappropriate shocks and mortality.

### **Ice Pack**

A device that applies cold to a body area to help relieve pain or swelling. It should be wrapped to protect the skin and used for limited periods.

### **ICF Framework**

International Classification of Functioning, Disability and Health. Biopsychosocial model: body functions/structures, activities, participation, environmental factors, personal factors.

### **Ichthyosis**

A group of disorders characterized by dry, scaly skin resembling fish scales. Ichthyosis vulgaris is the most common, autosomal dominant, associated with filaggrin mutation and atopy. X-linked ichthyosis is caused by steroid sulfatase deficiency. Lamellar ichthyosis is a severe congenital form.

### **Ichthyosis Vulgaris**

A common inherited disorder of skin keratinization characterized by dry, scaling skin, especially on the extensor limbs. Symptoms often improve with age and with regular emollient and keratolytic skin care.

### **ICU Psychosis**

A colloquial term for delirium occurring in an intensive-care setting, with acute changes in attention, awareness, and cognition. Causes include severe illness, infection, medicines, sleep disruption, pain, and metabolic abnormalities. It requires prompt evaluation and treatment of reversible causes, with supportive measures to orient and calm the patient.

**Synonyms:**  
Psychosis ICU (ICU Psychosis)

### **Ideas Of Reference**

The false belief that unrelated events, objects, or people have a particular and unusual significance specifically for the patient. For example, believing that TV newscasters are sending personal messages or that strangers are conspiring against them.

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## Idiopathic

Of unknown cause. Examples: idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis, idiopathic thrombocytopenia.

## Idiopathic Hypersomnia

A sleep disorder characterized by excessive daytime sleepiness, prolonged or unrefreshing sleep, difficulty awakening, and impaired alertness despite adequate opportunity for sleep. It is diagnosed after excluding other medical, psychiatric, circadian, and substance-related causes.

## Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension

Elevated intracranial pressure without mass lesion. Symptoms: headache, pulsatile tinnitus, visual changes, papilledema. Treatment: acetazolamide, weight loss, surgical options.

## Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis

A chronic, progressive fibrosing interstitial pneumonia of unknown cause. Histopathology shows usual interstitial pneumonia (UIP). Features include exertional dyspnea, dry cough, bibasilar crackles, and digital clubbing. Median survival is 3–5 years.

## Idiosyncratic Reaction

An uncommon, unexpected, and often genetically determined adverse drug reaction that is unrelated to the drug's known pharmacology and usually dose-independent (a Type B reaction).

## Idioventricular Rhythm

A ventricular rhythm arising from an ectopic focus in the His-Purkinje system or ventricular myocardium, typically at a slow rate with wide QRS complexes. It may occur during escape from higher pacemakers, reperfusion, conduction block, or severe cardiac disease.

## IgA

Immunoglobulin A, the predominant antibody in mucosal secretions (saliva, tears, breast milk, gastrointestinal and respiratory tract). Exists mainly as a dimer linked by a J chain and secretory component, which protects it from proteolysis.

## IgA Nephropathy

The most common primary glomerulonephritis worldwide, characterized by mesangial IgA deposition. Presents with hematuria (macroscopic with mucosal infections, especially upper respiratory), proteinuria, and hypertension. Most common in young adults, with male predominance.

## IgA Vasculitis

An immune-complex small-vessel vasculitis characterized by palpable purpura, joint pain, abdominal symptoms, and kidney involvement. It is common in children and may follow an infection; renal disease determines long-term risk.

## IgA Vasculitis (Henoch-Schonlein Purpura)

The most common systemic vasculitis in children (peak age 2–8 years), characterized by IgA1-containing immune complex deposition in small vessels. Often preceded by an upper respiratory tract infection (e.g., group A *Streptococcus*).

### Synonyms:

Henoch-Schonlein Purpura

## IgD

Immunoglobulin D, a membrane-bound antibody expressed on the surface of mature naive B cells (with IgM) serving as a B-cell receptor. Serum IgD is present in trace amounts and its secreted function is unclear. Its role in B-cell activation and signaling is an area of research.

## IgE

Immunoglobulin E, the antibody class mediating immediate (type I) hypersensitivity and defense against parasites. Binds high-affinity Fc-epsilon-RI receptors on mast cells and basophils; allergen cross-linking triggers degranulation and release of histamine and leukotrienes, causing allergic rhinitis, asthma, urticaria, and anaphylaxis.

## IgG

Immunoglobulin G, the most abundant antibody class in serum (75–80 percent), produced during secondary immune responses. Functions: neutraliza-

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tion, opsonization, complement activation (classical pathway), and antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity.

### **IgG And Complement Deposition At The Dermis-Epidermis Junction**

An immunofluorescence finding that may occur in the lupus band test, in which immune complexes containing immunoglobulin and complement deposit along the dermoepidermal junction. The pattern and clinical context are needed for interpretation.

### **IgG4-Related Disease**

A fibro-inflammatory disorder that can produce tumefactive lesions and organ enlargement in multiple sites. Histology may show IgG4-positive plasma cells, storiform fibrosis, and obliterative phlebitis; diagnosis requires clinicopathologic correlation because no single test is sufficient.

### **IgG4-Related Disease Arteritis**

A form of IgG4-related disease affecting large and medium-sized arteries, characterized by transmural inflammation with abundant IgG4-positive plasma cells, storiform fibrosis, and obliterative phlebitis. It may involve the aorta and its branches, causing stenosis or aneurysm formation.

### **IgG4-Related Ophthalmic Disease**

An immune-mediated fibroinflammatory disorder that can affect the lacrimal glands, orbit, eyelids, or extraocular muscles. It may cause swelling, mass lesions, double vision, or visual symptoms and can occur with IgG4-related disease in other organs.

### **IgM**

Immunoglobulin M, the largest antibody (pentamer), produced during the primary immune response (first antibody to appear). Functions: potent complement activation (classical pathway) and agglutination; expressed as a membrane-bound B-cell receptor on naive B cells.

### **IGRA (Interferon-Gamma Release Assay)**

Blood test for *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* infection (latent or active). T-SPOT.TB (ELISPOT) or

QuantiFERON-TB Gold Plus (ELISA). Measures IFN-gamma released by T cells after exposure to MTB-specific antigens (ESAT-6, CFP-10, TB7.7).

### **Synonyms:**

Interferon-Gamma Release Assay

### **Ileal Atresia**

Congenital complete interruption or absence of a segment of the ileal lumen. It causes neonatal intestinal obstruction with abdominal distension, bilious vomiting, and failure to pass meconium and generally requires surgical management.

### **Ileal Obstruction**

Partial or complete blockage of the ileum, the final portion of the small intestine. Causes include adhesions, hernia, inflammatory bowel disease, tumors, and twisting of the bowel. Symptoms may include cramping pain, vomiting, abdominal distension, and inability to pass stool or gas.

### **Ileal Pouch-Anal Anastomosis**

Surgical creation of a J-pouch from the terminal ileum after proctocolectomy to preserve intestinal continuity for ulcerative colitis. Avoids permanent ileostomy by allowing defecation through the anal route. The procedure involves removal of the entire colon and rectum with construction of a reservoir from distal ileum.

### **Ileitis**

Inflammation of the ileum, the distal segment of the small intestine. Causes include Crohn disease, infection, ischemia, medication-related injury, and other inflammatory disorders; symptoms may include right-lower-quadrant pain, diarrhea, fever, or bleeding.

### **Ileocecal Valve**

A sphincter-like fold at the junction of the terminal ileum and caecum. It regulates passage of intestinal contents into the colon and helps limit reflux of colonic contents into the small intestine.

### **Ileostomy**

An ileostomy brings the ileum through the abdomi-

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nal wall to divert intestinal contents into an external pouch when the colon or rectum cannot be used normally. after proctocolectomy for ulcerative colitis or familial adenomatous polyposis, or to protect a distal anastomosis. Output is liquid and enzyme-rich, requiring careful fluid and skin management.

### **Ileum**

Longest distal segment (3.5 m) with thinner walls, shorter villi, and Peyer's patches on the antimesenteric border. Absorbs vitamin B12, bile salts, remaining nutrients. Ileocecal valve prevents colonic backflow. Crohn's disease most commonly affects the terminal ileum; resection may cause B12 deficiency and bile salt malabsorption.

### **Ileus**

Failure of coordinated intestinal propulsion without a mechanical blockage, usually from postoperative bowel inhibition, inflammation, metabolic disturbance, or medication effect. It causes distension, nausea, vomiting, and reduced passage of flatus or stool.

### **Iliotibial Band Syndrome**

Lateral knee pain from IT band friction over lateral femoral epicondyle. Common in runners. Treatment: rest, stretching, strengthening, biomechanical correction.

#### **Synonyms:**

ITBS (Iliotibial Band Syndrome)

### **Ilium**

Largest hip bone forming the superior portion. Body contributes to acetabulum; wing has a concave iliac fossa. Iliac crest runs ASIS to PSIS, a palpable landmark for lumbar puncture level. Sacroiliac joint articulates with sacrum. Gluteal muscles originate from its external surface; iliacus fills its fossa.

### **Illness Anxiety Disorder**

Preoccupation with having or acquiring a serious illness, with minimal or no somatic symptoms present. The individual has a high level of anxiety about health, performs excessive health-related behaviors, and experiences maladaptive avoidance. Symptoms

persist for at least six months. The individual is not delusional and insight may vary.

### **Image-Guided Ablation**

Destruction of abnormal tissue using an energy source such as heat, cold, or chemicals while imaging guides placement and monitors the procedure.

### **Image-Guided Biopsy**

Removal of a tissue sample with the position of the needle or instrument guided by ultrasound, CT, MRI, or fluoroscopy.

### **Image-Guided Drainage**

Placement of a catheter or needle under imaging guidance to evacuate fluid, pus, blood, or bile from a pathologic collection. Indications include abscess, biloma, urinoma, pleural collection, and symptomatic cysts.

### **Image-Guided Therapy**

A minimally invasive procedure performed with imaging to guide instruments or treatment to a target tissue.

### **Imaging**

The production of pictures of internal body structures using methods such as radiography, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, or nuclear medicine.

### **Imaging-Guided Biopsy**

Tissue acquisition directed by ultrasound, CT, MRI, or fluoroscopy to target a lesion while avoiding critical structures. The procedure requires appropriate specimen handling, informed consent, bleeding-risk assessment, and post-procedure monitoring.

### **Iminoacetic Acid Scan**

A nuclear-medicine examination using a technetium-labeled iminodiacetic acid compound to evaluate hepatobiliary function and bile flow. It is not primarily a renal scan.

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## Immediate Hypersensitivity

A rapid, typically immunoglobulin-E-mediated hypersensitivity reaction in which allergen cross-linking of mast-cell or basophil receptors releases inflammatory mediators. It can cause urticaria, bronchospasm, gastrointestinal symptoms, or anaphylaxis.

## Immune And Infectious Diseases

A medical field encompassing disorders of the immune system and illnesses caused by pathogenic microorganisms. Immune system disorders include autoimmune diseases (e.g., lupus, rheumatoid arthritis), immunodeficiencies, and hypersensitivity reactions.

## Immune Checkpoint

An inhibitory or stimulatory receptor-ligand pathway that regulates lymphocyte activation and limits tissue injury. Therapeutic blockade of inhibitory checkpoints such as CTLA-4 or PD-1 can enhance antitumor immunity but may cause immune-related adverse effects.

## Immune Complex

A soluble or tissue-associated aggregate formed by antigen bound to antibody. Persistent or inadequately cleared immune complexes may activate complement and deposit in tissues, producing type III hypersensitivity and vasculitic or renal injury.

## Immune Evasion

The ability of a pathogen, tumor, or other abnormal cell to avoid recognition or destruction by the immune system.

## Immune Hemolytic Anemia

Anemia caused by immune-mediated destruction of red blood cells, either by autoantibodies or antibodies directed against foreign red-cell antigens. It may cause fatigue, jaundice, dark urine, splenomegaly, and laboratory evidence of hemolysis.

## Immune Response

The coordinated reaction of the immune system to foreign substances (antigens), pathogens, or abnormal

cells. The innate immune response acts rapidly and non-specifically (physical barriers, phagocytes, complement, NK cells, inflammation).

## Immune Thrombocytopenia

An autoimmune disorder characterized by isolated thrombocytopenia (platelet count  $<100 \times 10^9/L$ ) due to autoantibody-mediated platelet destruction and impaired platelet production. Primary ITP (no identifiable cause) vs secondary (SLE, CLL, HIV, HCV, drugs).

## Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura

An autoimmune bleeding disorder characterized by isolated thrombocytopenia (platelet count  $<100,000/L$ ) with normal white blood cell count and hemoglobin. Caused by autoantibodies (primarily IgG) directed against platelet surface glycoproteins (IIb/IIIa or Ib/IX), leading to splenic macrophage phagocytosis of platelets.

## Immune Tolerance

The state of unresponsiveness of the immune system to self-antigens and to specific foreign antigens, preventing autoimmunity while preserving responses to pathogens. Central tolerance: deletion of self-reactive lymphocytes in the thymus (T cells) and bone marrow (B cells).

## Immune-Mediated Necrotizing Myopathy

A subacute severe proximal myopathy with very high CK (often  $>10,000$ ), minimal inflammation on biopsy, necrotic fibers. Two major autoantibodies: anti-HMGCR (3-hydroxy-3-methylglutaryl-CoA reductase, statin-associated or spontaneous) and anti-SRP (signal recognition particle).

## Immune-Related Adverse Event

An inflammatory or autoimmune toxicity caused by immune checkpoint blockade or another immune-activating cancer treatment. It may affect skin, bowel, liver, endocrine organs, lungs, heart, kidneys, or nervous system and often requires treatment-specific immunosuppression.



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## Immunization

The process of inducing protection against an infection, usually through vaccination. Recommended vaccines and schedules depend on age, previous doses, pregnancy, immune status, medical conditions, travel, exposure risk, and current public-health guidance.

## Immunocompromised Host

A person whose immune defenses are impaired by congenital disease, infection, malignancy, immunosuppressive treatment, organ failure, or another condition. Such patients have increased susceptibility to opportunistic infection, severe disease, and atypical presentations.

## Immunodeficiency

Impaired development or function of one or more components of the immune system, resulting in increased susceptibility to infection, malignancy, or autoimmunity. It may be primary and genetic or secondary to disease, medication, malnutrition, or another acquired cause.

## Immunodeficiency And Infections

Immunocompromised individuals are at increased risk for opportunistic infections. Primary immunodeficiencies are genetic disorders affecting immune function. Secondary immunodeficiencies include HIV/AIDS, organ transplantation, chemotherapy, and corticosteroid use.

## Immunodeficiency Diseases

Disorders in which one or more components of the immune system are absent, deficient, or dysfunctional. They may be inherited or acquired and can cause recurrent, severe, unusual, or persistent infections, autoimmune disease, and increased malignancy risk.

## Immunofluorescence

A technique using fluorescently labeled antibodies to detect specific antigens in tissues, cells, or microorganisms; visualized by fluorescence microscopy.

## Immunoglobulin (Antibody)

Y-shaped glycoprotein produced by plasma cells that specifically binds antigens. Composed of two identical heavy chains and two identical light chains linked by disulfide bonds. Variable regions (Fab) bind antigen; constant region (Fc) mediates effector functions (complement activation, Fc receptor binding).

### Synonyms:

Antibody

## Immunoglobulin Replacement Therapy

Indications: primary antibody deficiencies (XLA, CVID, hyper-IgM, specific antibody deficiency), secondary hypogammaglobulinemia (CLL, myeloma, post-rituximab, post-transplant) with recurrent infections.

## Immunohistochemistry

A technique that uses labeled antibodies to detect specific antigens in tissue sections. It supports tumor classification, identification of lineage, assessment of predictive biomarkers, and detection of infectious or immune-mediated processes.

## Immunological Memory

The ability of the adaptive immune system to mount a faster, larger, and more effective response upon re-exposure to an antigen, conferred by long-lived memory B cells and memory T cells generated during the primary response.

## Immunomodulators In Dermatology

Topical immunomodulators treat inflammatory skin diseases without corticosteroid side effects. Pimecrolimus 1 percent cream and tacrolimus 0.03 and 0.1 percent ointments are calcineurin inhibitors used for atopic dermatitis, facial eczema, and intertriginous areas. They are steroid-sparing agents.

## Immunophenotyping

Identification and characterization of cells according to their surface, cytoplasmic, or nuclear antigens, usually by flow cytometry or immunohistochemistry. It is used to classify leukemias, lymphomas, immune-cell subsets, and some immunodeficiency disorders.



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## Immunosenescence

Age-related changes in innate and adaptive immunity that alter infection susceptibility, vaccine responses, inflammation, and cancer surveillance. It is influenced by chronic disease, nutrition, medications, and functional status.

## Immunosuppressant

A drug that reduces immune system activity, used to prevent organ transplant rejection and to treat autoimmune and inflammatory diseases.

## Immunosuppression In Transplant

Medications to prevent rejection. Induction with thymoglobulin or basiliximab. Maintenance with tacrolimus, mycophenolate, and prednisone. Monitor drug levels and renal function. Calcineurin inhibitor nephrotoxicity is major concern requiring dose optimization.

## Immunosuppression Screening

Pre-treatment evaluation for latent or active infection, vaccination status, malignancy risk, and organ dysfunction before immunosuppressive therapy. Testing commonly includes tuberculosis, hepatitis B and C, HIV, blood counts, liver and kidney function, and pregnancy when relevant.

## Immunosuppressive Drug

A drug that suppresses immune responses, used for organ transplantation, graft-versus-host disease, and autoimmune/inflammatory diseases.

## Immunotherapy

Treatment using immune system to fight cancer. Types: checkpoint inhibitors (PD-1, PD-L1, CTLA-4), CAR T-cell therapy, cytokines, cancer vaccines. Examples: pembrolizumab, nivolumab, ipilimumab, axicabtagene ciloleucel.

## Immunotherapy And Biologic Treatments

Advanced therapies that harness or modify the immune system to treat diseases, particularly cancer, autoimmune disorders, and inflammatory conditions. Biologics are large-molecule drugs derived from living organisms that target specific immune pathways,

such as TNF inhibitors, monoclonal antibodies, and checkpoint inhibitors.

## Immunotherapy In Dermatology

Cancer immunotherapy uses medicines that alter immune activity against skin cancers. Checkpoint inhibitors target pathways such as PD-1, PD-L1, or CTLA-4. Their use depends on the tumor type, stage, prior treatment, and the patient's health.

## Immunotoxicity

Immune system damage from chemicals. Effects: immunosuppression, hypersensitivity, autoimmunity. Examples: benzene, chemotherapy, biologics.

## Impacted Tooth

Tooth unable to erupt into functional position. Most common: mandibular third molars, maxillary canines. May cause pathology: cyst, root resorption, caries. Treatment: monitoring or extraction.

## Impedance Hearing Testing

A group of tests, including tympanometry, that measure the movement of the eardrum and middle-ear function.

## Impella Device

Percutaneous microaxial left ventricular assist device that actively pumps blood from the LV into the aorta, reducing LV workload and increasing cardiac output. Types: Impella 2.5 (up to 2.5 L/min), Impella CP (up to 3.7 L/min), Impella 5.0 (up to 5 L/min, surgically placed).

## Imperforate Anus

A congenital anomaly where the anus is completely absent or fails to open at the perineum. Classified as low (distal to the levator ani complex) or high (proximal to the levator ani). Often associated with other anomalies including vertebral, anal, cardiac, tracheoesophageal, renal, and limb defects.

## Imperforate Hymen

A congenital obstruction of the vaginal opening by an intact hymen without a normal central opening.

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After puberty it may cause absent menstruation, cyclic pelvic pain, urinary retention, or a pelvic mass from retained menstrual blood.

### **Impetigo**

Impetigo is a superficial contagious bacterial skin infection producing fragile blisters or honey-colored crusts, commonly caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* or *Streptococcus pyogenes*. affecting children.

#### **Synonyms:**

School Sores (Impetigo)

### **Implant (Dental)**

A biocompatible fixture placed in the jawbone to support a dental prosthesis. It may be used for one missing tooth or to support a partial or complete denture; complications include infection, bone loss, and mechanical failure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Implant Failure**

Loss of an implant's intended structural, biologic, or functional performance. Causes include infection, fracture, loosening, wear, malposition, thrombosis, material degradation, and patient or tissue factors.

### **Implant Sterilization**

Validated processing that removes or inactivates all viable microorganisms, including bacterial spores, from an implant. Methods include moist heat, ethylene oxide, radiation, and low-temperature plasma according to material and device requirements.

### **Implant-Associated Infection**

Infection involving an implanted medical device or the tissue surrounding it. Microbial adherence and biofilm formation can impair antimicrobial penetration and often require device-directed therapy, source control, or removal.

### **Implant-Supported Prosthesis**

A fixed or removable dental prosthesis that is supported or retained by one or more dental implants.

### **Implantable Cardioverter Defibrillator**

An implanted device that detects dangerous ventricular rhythms and treats them with antitachycardia pacing or an electrical shock.

### **Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator**

An implanted device that monitors heart rhythm and delivers electrical therapy (antitachycardia pacing or defibrillation) for life-threatening ventricular arrhythmias.

### **Implantable Loop Recorder**

Subcutaneous device providing continuous ECG monitoring for up to 3 years. Used for evaluation of unexplained syncope, recurrent palpitations, cryptogenic stroke, and occult atrial fibrillation detection. Small size (coin-sized), inserted under local anesthesia in the chest.

### **Implantable Port**

A subcutaneously placed vascular-access device consisting of a reservoir connected to a catheter, used for repeated administration of medication, fluids, blood products, or parenteral nutrition. It requires sterile access and may be complicated by infection, thrombosis, occlusion, or mechanical failure.

### **Implantation**

The embedding of the blastocyst into the endometrium, occurring approximately 6-10 days after ovulation. The blastocyst hatches from the zona pellucida, and the trophoblast invades the decidua. Implantation triggers hCG production, which maintains the corpus luteum. Failure of implantation is a common cause of early pregnancy loss.

### **Impression**

Summary of key findings and recommendations in radiology report.

### **Imprinting**

A pattern of gene expression determined by whether a gene copy was inherited from the mother or father.

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### **Impulse Oscillometry**

A pulmonary function testing technique that measures respiratory impedance by applying small pressure oscillations during tidal breathing. It assesses large airway resistance (R5), small airway resistance (R5-R20), and reactance.

### **In Situ Carcinoma**

Abnormal malignant cells confined to the tissue layer in which they arose and not yet invading through the basement membrane.

### **In Vitro Fertilisation**

An assisted reproductive technology in which eggs are retrieved from the ovaries, fertilized with sperm in a laboratory, and resulting embryos are transferred to the uterus.

### **Inactivated Polio Vaccine**

Salk vaccine, a formalin-inactivated preparation containing all three poliovirus serotypes (1, 2, and 3), administered by intramuscular injection. The only polio vaccine used in the United States since 2000, and the recommended vaccine for immunocompromised individuals and pregnant women worldwide.

### **Inborn Error Of Metabolism**

An inherited disorder caused by a defect in a metabolic pathway, often resulting in accumulation of harmful substances or deficiency of essential products.

### **Incentive Spirometry**

A device that provides visual feedback while a person inhales slowly and deeply. It may be used with coughing, mobilization, and other measures to support lung expansion after illness or surgery.

### **Incidence**

Incidence is the number of new cases of a disease or event arising in a population during a specified period.

### **Incidental Finding**

An unexpected observation discovered during an

examination performed for another reason. Its importance depends on the finding and the clinical context.

### **Incidentaloma**

Incidental imaging finding of uncertain significance. May require further evaluation.

### **Incised Wound**

Clean-cut wound produced by a sharp-edged instrument (scalpel, knife, glass) that is longer on the skin surface than it is deep, featuring clean edges without tissue bridging or marginal abrasion.

### **Incisional Biopsy**

Surgical removal of part of lesion. Diagnosis before definitive treatment.

### **Incisional Hernia**

A hernia through a weakness in a previous surgical incision. It may appear as a bulge that becomes more prominent with standing or straining. Risk factors include wound infection, obesity, smoking, poor nutrition, chronic cough, and repeated surgery.

### **Inclusion Body Myositis**

A slowly progressive inflammatory and degenerative muscle disease, usually causing asymmetric weakness of the finger flexors and quadriceps. Muscle biopsy may show endomysial inflammation and rimmed vacuoles. Response to immunotherapy is often limited.

### **Inclusion-Cell (I-Cell) Disease**

A rare inherited lysosomal-storage disorder caused by impaired tagging and trafficking of lysosomal enzymes, leading to their secretion outside cells. It causes severe developmental delay, skeletal abnormalities, coarse facial features, and progressive multisystem disease. Management is supportive and coordinated by specialists.

#### **Synonyms:**

I-Cell

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## Incontinence

The involuntary loss of control over urination (urinary incontinence) or defecation (fecal incontinence).

### Incontinence (Fecal)

Involuntary fecal leakage. Causes: diarrhea, constipation with overflow, sphincter damage, neurological disease, medications. Assessment: history, examination, anorectal manometry. Treatment: bowel regimen, sphincter exercises, biofeedback, surgery if indicated.

#### Synonyms:

Fecal

### Incontinence (Urinary)

Involuntary urine leakage. Types: stress (cough/sneeze), urge (overactive bladder), overflow (retention), functional (immobility/cognition), mixed. Assessment: history, bladder diary, urinalysis, post-void residual.

#### Synonyms:

Urinary

## Incontinentia Pigmenti

An X-linked dominant disorder affecting skin, teeth, eyes, and the nervous system, caused by pathogenic variants in IKBKG. Skin lesions evolve through vesicular, verrucous, hyperpigmented, and atrophic stages and may be associated with retinal disease or seizures.

## Increased Intracranial Pressure

Abnormally elevated pressure within the skull caused by brain swelling, hemorrhage, mass lesion, impaired cerebrospinal-fluid circulation, or venous obstruction. It can cause headache, vomiting, visual disturbance, reduced consciousness, and brain herniation.

## Increased Vascular Permeability

A fundamental feature of acute inflammation that allows plasma proteins, fluid, and leukocytes to exit the vascular space and enter the extravascular tissue.

## Incubation Period

The time between when a person is exposed to an infection and when symptoms appear.

## Incubator

A controlled-environment chamber culturing microorganisms, cells, or tissues at defined temperature, humidity, and atmospheric composition.

## Incus

The incus, commonly known as the anvil, is the middle ossicle of the three bones in the middle ear, articulating with the malleus at the incudomalleolar joint and with the stapes at the incudostapedial joint.

## Independence

The ability to perform activities and make decisions without assistance, although a person may still use devices, adaptations, or occasional support.

## India Immunization Schedule

The Universal Immunization Schedule (UIP) of the Government of India, providing free vaccines to all children, adolescents, and pregnant women through the public health system.

## Indication

A clinical condition, symptom, or question that provides the reason for performing a test, procedure, or treatment.

## Indigestion

A chemical substance or compound called indigestion. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

## Indirect Antiglobulin Test

A test that detects free, clinically significant antibodies in a patient's serum or plasma by incubating it with reagent erythrocytes. It is used for antibody screening, compatibility testing, and prenatal red-cell antibody evaluation.

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### Indirect Calorimetry

Measurement of oxygen consumption and carbon-dioxide production to estimate resting energy expenditure. It is the preferred method for determining energy needs when prediction equations are unreliable, particularly in critically ill or metabolically complex patients.

### Indirect Veneer

Ceramic restoration fabricated in lab. Porcelain or composite. Aesthetic enhancement.

### Indium-111

SPECT radionuclide, half-life 2.8 days. Used in WBC labeling, octreotide scanning. Emits gamma rays at 171 and 245 keV.

### Indium-111 Scan

Nuclear medicine imaging using In-111. Used for WBC labeling, octreotide scanning.

### Indoor Allergens

Substances inside buildings that can trigger allergic or asthma symptoms, including dust mites, mold, cockroach particles, and animal dander. Exposure may cause rhinitis, conjunctivitis, wheezing, or eczema. Reduction of exposure and appropriate allergy or asthma treatment depend on the identified trigger.

### Induced Sputum Analysis

A method of assessing airway inflammation by examining sputum produced after inhaled saline stimulation. The types and proportions of inflammatory cells may support assessment of asthma, infection, COPD, or bronchiectasis.

### Induction Of Labor

The artificial initiation of uterine contractions before the onset of spontaneous labor.

### Induction Therapy

Intensive initial treatment aimed at achieving remission, especially in acute leukemias.

### Infant Botulism

A neuromuscular illness caused by intestinal colonization with *Clostridium botulinum* and production of botulinum neurotoxin in infants. It causes constipation, poor feeding, weak cry, hypotonia, facial weakness, and descending paralysis.

### Infant Feeding

Provision of breast milk, appropriately prepared formula, or both to meet an infant's energy, protein, fluid, and micronutrient requirements. Feeding recommendations depend on age, growth, medical conditions, developmental readiness, and safe preparation practices.

### Infant Harlequin Syndrome

A transient, benign cutaneous vascular phenomenon in neonates characterized by asymmetric flushing of one half of the body with sharp midline demarcation, caused by transient asymmetric sympathetic tone. The affected side is red and warm while the contralateral side is pale.

### Infant Sleep Position

Placing an infant on the back for every sleep is recommended to reduce the risk of sleep-related death. Infants should sleep on a firm, separate surface without pillows, loose bedding, bumpers, or stuffed toys.

### Infanticide

The killing of a child, in law typically defined as the killing of a newborn or infant (usually within the first year, or specifically within 24 hours of birth in some jurisdictions) by its mother while mentally disturbed by the effects of childbirth or lactation.

### Infantile Colic

A behavioral syndrome in healthy infants characterized by episodes of excessive, inconsolable crying for >3 hours per day, >3 days per week, for >3 weeks (Wessel criteria). Onset typically at 2-3 weeks, peaks at 6-8 weeks, and resolves by 3-4 months of age.

### Infantile Hepatic Hemangiomas

Benign vascular tumors of the liver occurring in in-

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fants, typically presenting within the first six months of life with hepatomegaly, high-output cardiac failure, consumptive hypothyroidism, or cutaneous hemangiomas. Large tumors may cause abdominal compartment syndrome and thrombocytopenia from Kasabach-Merritt phenomenon.

### **Infarction**

Tissue death from prolonged ischemia. Examples: myocardial infarction, cerebral infarction.

### **Infection**

Measures to prevent healthcare-associated infections: hand hygiene, personal protective equipment (PPE), isolation precautions (contact, droplet, airborne), sterilization, disinfection. See infection control.

### **Infection (Geriatric)**

Infectious diseases in elderly often present atypically: fever may be absent, confusion may be sole symptom. Common infections: UTI, pneumonia, skin/soft tissue, bloodstream. Prevention: vaccination, hand hygiene, aspiration precautions. Treatment: earlier presentation, broader differential, drug interactions, renal dosing.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Infection Control**

Measures to prevent healthcare-associated infections: hand hygiene, personal protective equipment (PPE), isolation precautions (contact, droplet, airborne), sterilization, disinfection. Multidrug-resistant organisms: MRSA, VRE, *C. difficile*, carbapenem-resistant Enterobacteriaceae.

### **Infection Imaging**

WBC scanning, gallium scanning, FDG PET. Detection of occult infection.

### **Infection Prevention**

Measures that reduce the risk of infection, including hand hygiene, personal protective equipment, environmental cleaning, sterilization, disinfection, vaccination, and appropriate isolation precautions.

### **Infections In Pregnancy**

Listeriosis: *Listeria monocytogenes* (deli meats, soft cheese), meningoenitis, fetal loss, neonatal sepsis. Ampicillin + gentamicin. GBS: vaginal colonization 20-30 percent of pregnant women; universal screening at 35-37 weeks; intrapartum prophylaxis (penicillin G) for GBS-positive women to prevent early-onset neonatal disease.

### **Infectious Arthritis**

Inflammation of a joint caused by infection, usually bacterial and sometimes viral or fungal. Acute pain, swelling, warmth, fever, and restricted movement require urgent evaluation because joint damage can develop quickly.

### **Infectious Disease**

Disease caused by pathogen. Examples: bacterial, viral, fungal, parasitic.

### **Infectious Dose**

The number of viable organisms required to establish infection in a host under specified conditions. The dose depends on the pathogen, route of exposure, host defenses, and organism viability.

### **Infectious Esophagitis**

Inflammation of the esophagus caused by an infectious organism, most often *Candida*, herpes simplex virus, or cytomegalovirus in immunocompromised patients. It commonly causes painful swallowing, difficulty swallowing, and retrosternal pain.

### **Infectious Meningitis**

Infection and inflammation of the membranes surrounding the brain and spinal cord. Bacterial meningitis is a medical emergency; headache, fever, neck stiffness, vomiting, confusion, or a new rash requires immediate medical attention.

### **Infectious Myringitis**

Inflammation and infection of the tympanic membrane, often associated with viral or bacterial respiratory infection. It can cause severe ear pain, fever, hearing reduction, and small fluid-filled blisters on the eardrum.



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### Infective Endocarditis

Infection of the endocardial surface of the heart, most commonly affecting the heart valves. It is diagnosed using the Duke criteria, which include major criteria (positive blood cultures, echocardiographic evidence of vegetations) and minor criteria (predisposing heart condition, fever, vascular phenomena, immunologic phenomena).

### Inferior

Positioned lower or closer to the feet.

### Inferior Alveolar Nerve Block

A regional anesthetic injection near the mandibular foramen to anesthetize the inferior alveolar nerve before it enters the mandibular canal. It usually anesthetizes mandibular teeth on that side; the lingual nerve is often anesthetized incidentally.

### Inferior Hemifield Loss

Loss of vision in the lower half of the visual field in one or both eyes, which localises to lesions of the superior retina or superior optic radiations passing through the parietal lobe. Causes include superior retinal detachment, branch retinal artery occlusion, and parietal lobe stroke.

### Inferior Mesenteric Artery

Third major abdominal aortic branch at L3, the hindgut artery. Supplies distal transverse colon through rectum. Branches: left colic, sigmoid, superior rectal. The marginal artery of Drummond provides SMA-IMA collateral circulation. Occlusion may cause ischemic colitis at the splenic flexure watershed (Griffiths' point).

### Inferior Vena Cava

Body's largest vein, formed by common iliac vein union at L5, returning lower body deoxygenated blood to the right atrium. Ascends right of the aorta, pierces the diaphragm at T8, enters the pericardium. Receives hepatic, renal, gonadal, and lumbar veins. IVC thrombosis/compression causes bilateral lower extremity edema and DVT.

### Infertility

Infertility is failure to achieve pregnancy after a defined period of regular unprotected intercourse, reflecting factors involving ovulation, sperm, reproductive anatomy, age, or unexplained causes. to conceive or carry a pregnancy. Causes may involve ovulation, reproductive anatomy, sperm, age-related fertility, medical conditions, or unexplained factors.

#### Synonyms:

Subfertility

### Infiltrate

Patchy lung opacity detected on imaging. Non-specific, may represent infection, edema, hemorrhage, inflammation.

### Inflammaging

Persistent, low-grade, age-associated inflammatory activity linked to cellular senescence, immune dysregulation, chronic infection, tissue injury, and comorbidity. It contributes to frailty, atherosclerosis, sarcopenia, and neurodegenerative disease.

### Inflammasomes

Multiprotein complexes activating caspase-1 -> cleavage of pro-IL-1 $\beta$ /pro-IL-18 -> mature IL-1 $\beta$ /IL-18 + pyroptosis (gasdermin D pores). Canonical: NLRP3 (crystals, ATP, K<sup>+</sup> efflux, ROS, lysosomal rupture), NLRC4 (flagellin, T3SS), AIM2 (cytosolic DNA), Pyrin (RhoA inactivation).

### Inflammation

The body's protective response to injury or infection. Cardinal signs: redness (rubor), heat (calor), swelling (tumor), pain (dolor), loss of function (functio laesa). Mediators: histamine, prostaglandins, cytokines, complement. Acute: neutrophil-predominant. Chronic: lymphocyte/macrophage-predominant.

### Inflammation (Dietary)

Chronic low-grade inflammation linked to diet. Western diet pro-inflammatory (saturated fat, sugar, refined grains). Mediterranean diet anti-inflammatory.

#### Synonyms:

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Dietary

### **Inflammation Imaging**

FDG PET sensitive for inflammatory processes. Differentiate infection from malignancy challenging.

### **Inflammatory Back Pain**

A pattern of chronic back pain characterized by insidious onset, improvement with exercise, lack of improvement with rest, nocturnal pain, and prolonged morning stiffness. It suggests axial spondyloarthritis but is not diagnostic without supportive clinical, laboratory, and imaging findings.

### **Inflammatory Bowel Disease**

Chronic relapsing inflammatory conditions of the gastrointestinal tract encompassing Crohn disease and ulcerative colitis, resulting from a dysregulated immune response in genetically susceptible individuals triggered by environmental factors and alterations in the gut microbiome.

### **Inflammatory Bowel Disease Diet**

Crohn disease, ulcerative colitis. Nutritional support during flares. Exclusive enteral nutrition for Crohn induction. Individual triggers vary.

### **Inflammatory Myopathies**

A group of autoimmune disorders characterized by chronic muscle inflammation and progressive proximal muscle weakness. The three main types are dermatomyositis, polymyositis, and inclusion body myositis.

### **Influenza**

A contagious respiratory illness caused by influenza A or B viruses, characterized by sudden onset of fever, myalgia, headache, malaise, nonproductive cough, sore throat, and nasal congestion. Seasonal epidemics occur annually. Complications: pneumonia (primary viral or secondary bacterial), exacerbation of underlying conditions.

### **Influenza Test**

A test for influenza A or B using a respiratory spec-

imen. Rapid antigen tests provide quick results but may miss infection. Molecular tests are generally more sensitive and may identify or subtype influenza viruses; results must be interpreted with symptoms, timing, and local laboratory methods.

### **Influenza Vaccination In Pregnancy**

Annual inactivated influenza vaccine recommended for all pregnant women. Pregnancy increases the risk of severe influenza (pneumonia, ICU admission, death) due to changes in immune function and cardiopulmonary physiology.

### **Influenza Vaccine**

Inactivated influenza vaccine given annually starting at 6 months of age. Two doses needed in the first season for children under 9. Live attenuated nasal spray vaccine (FluMist) available for children over 2. Updated annually to match circulating strains. Reduces influenza complications, hospitalizations, and deaths.

### **Influenza Virus**

A segmented, negative-sense RNA virus belonging to the Orthomyxoviridae family. Influenza causes seasonal epidemics and occasional pandemics of respiratory illness. The virus has two surface glycoproteins: hemagglutinin (HA), which mediates attachment, and neuraminidase (NA), which facilitates release.

### **Informed Consent (Geriatric)**

Process of obtaining voluntary authorization from elderly patient with decision-making capacity. Capacity assessment: understanding, appreciation, reasoning, communication of choice. Impaired capacity may require surrogate decision-maker.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Infusion Pump**

Device controlling IV fluid delivery rate. Types: syringe pump, volumetric pump, elastomer. Precision: mL/hour. Alarms: occlusion, air embolism, completion.

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## Ingestion

The act of taking a substance into the digestive tract by swallowing. Ingestion of a toxic substance can cause poisoning.

## Ingrown Toenail

Ingrown toenail (onychocryptosis) occurs when the nail edge grows into the surrounding skin, causing pain, redness, and swelling. It is common in adolescents and adults, exacerbated by improper nail trimming, tight shoes, and trauma. Treatment includes partial nail avulsion with matrixectomy (phenol application) for recurrent cases.

### Synonyms:

Onychocryptosis (Ingrown Toenail)

## Inguinal Canal

An oblique passage (4 cm) through the anterior abdominal wall, from the deep (internal) inguinal ring to the superficial (external) inguinal ring, transmitting the spermatic cord in males and round ligament in females, plus ilioinguinal and genital branch of genitofemoral nerves.

## Inguinal Hernia

Protrusion of abdominal contents through the inguinal canal. Indirect (lateral to inferior epigastric vessels, through deep inguinal ring): congenital, patent processus vaginalis; most common overall (60-70%), male predominance.

## Inguinal Region

Area at the thigh-trunk junction traversed by the inguinal ligament (ASIS to pubic tubercle). Clinically significant for inguinal hernias: indirect (through deep inguinal ring, most common) and direct (through Hesselbach's triangle).

## Inhalation Injury

Thermal or chemical injury to the airway or lungs caused by smoke, heated gases, or toxic combustion products. It can produce upper-airway edema, bronchospasm, impaired mucociliary clearance, and carbon-monoxide or cyanide toxicity and may worsen after the initial burn.

## Inhalational Anesthesia

Anesthetic maintenance or induction using volatile liquids or gases delivered through the respiratory tract. Depth is influenced by inspired concentration, alveolar ventilation, uptake, distribution, and the agent's blood-gas solubility.

## Inhaled Corticosteroids

Anti-inflammatory medications delivered directly to the airways, reducing airway inflammation, mucus production, and bronchial hyperresponsiveness. Examples include fluticasone, budesonide, beclomethasone, and mometasone. They are the cornerstone of asthma maintenance therapy. Side effects include oral candidiasis and dysphonia.

## Inhaled Nitric Oxide

A selective pulmonary vasodilator used in acute settings (acute respiratory failure, right heart failure, post-cardiac surgery). It reduces pulmonary vascular resistance and improves oxygenation by dilating well-ventilated pulmonary vessels (improving V/Q matching). It has a short half-life and requires continuous delivery.

## Inhaler

Device for administering aerosolized medication. Types: MDI (metered-dose), DPI (dry powder).

## Iniencephaly

A rare, usually lethal neural-tube defect characterized by occipital bone defect, severe retroflexion of the head, and marked shortening or distortion of the cervical and thoracic spine. It is often identified prenatally and may occur with other congenital anomalies.

## Injury Classification (Abrasion, Laceration, Contusion, Incised Wounds)

Forensic categorization of mechanical wounds. Abrasion: superficial friction injury affecting only the epidermis (e.g., scrape, graze, pattern abrasion).

### Synonyms:

Abrasion, Laceration, Contusion, Incised Wounds

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## Injury Dating

Estimation of the age of an injury using clinical appearance, histopathology, imaging, and the history of symptoms. Exact dating is often uncertain, particularly for bruises and soft-tissue injuries, and findings should be reported with appropriate limitations.

## Innate Immune Evasion

Mechanisms by which pathogens evade the innate immune system. Strategies include capsules that prevent phagocytosis, biofilms that protect against immune cells, and intracellular survival within macrophages. Some bacteria produce enzymes that degrade complement components. Others modify their surface molecules to avoid recognition.

## Innate Immunity

First line of defense against pathogens, present from birth. Rapid (minutes to hours), germline-encoded, lacks immunological memory.

## Innate Lymphoid Cells

ILCs: lymphoid lineage, no rearranged antigen receptors, mirror Th subsets. ILC1 (T-bet, IFN-gamma): intracellular pathogens, IBD. ILC2 (GATA3, IL-5/13): helminths, allergy, asthma, tissue repair. ILC3 (ROR-gammat, IL-17/22): extracellular bacteria/fungi, lymphoid organogenesis.

## Inner Ear

The deepest part of the ear, consisting of the cochlea and the labyrinth.

## Inoculation

The introduction of microorganisms or clinical material into a culture medium, host, or sterile site to initiate growth, infection, or immune response.

## Inotrope

A drug that increases myocardial contractility (positive inotropy), used for cardiogenic shock, decompensated heart failure, and perioperative low-output states. Agents: dobutamine (beta-1 agonist), milrinone (PDE3 inhibitor), dopamine, epinephrine, norepinephrine (also vasopressors), and digoxin

(chronic).

## Inotropes In Anesthesia

Inotropes increase myocardial contractility. Dobutamine is a beta-1 and beta-2 agonist increasing cardiac output with minimal effect on heart rate. Dose: 2 to 20 mcg/kg/min infusion. Milrinone is a phosphodiesterase-3 inhibitor increasing contractility and causing vasodilation.

## Inpatient Rehabilitation

Intensive inpatient rehabilitation (3+ hours therapy/day) for acute conditions: stroke, spinal cord injury, traumatic brain injury, major trauma. See acute rehabilitation.

## INR

International normalized ratio: a standardized measure of the prothrombin time (PT), calculated as  $(\text{patient PT} / \text{mean normal PT})^{\text{ISI}}$ , to ensure consistent monitoring of vitamin K antagonist (warfarin) therapy across laboratories. Target INR: 2-3 for most indications (AF, VTE); 2.5-3.5 for mechanical heart valves.

## Insect Bite

A cutaneous reaction resulting from the injection of salivary contents from an insect during feeding, causing a localized or systemic hypersensitivity response. Common presentations include a pruritic papule or wheal with surrounding erythema. Severe reactions may include anaphylaxis, particularly with Hymenoptera stings.

## Insect Sting Allergies

Immune reactions to venom from insects such as bees, wasps, hornets, and fire ants. Reactions may be local or systemic; generalized hives, breathing difficulty, dizziness, vomiting, or throat swelling may indicate anaphylaxis and require emergency treatment.

### Synonyms:

Allergy Insect (Insect Sting Allergies)

## Insomnia

Insomnia is persistent difficulty initiating or main-

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taining sleep, or early awakening, with daytime impairment despite adequate opportunity and circumstances for sleep. too early despite adequate opportunity for sleep, with resulting daytime impairment. It may be acute or chronic and is often triggered by stress, anxiety, depression, or poor sleep habits.

**Synonyms:**  
Sleeplessness

### **Insomnia Disorder**

Difficulty initiating or maintaining sleep, or early-morning awakening with inability to return to sleep, at least three nights per week for at least three months. The individual experiences clinically significant distress or impairment in functioning.

### **Inspection**

A clinical condition or finding involving inspection. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context. the patient's overall appearance, posture, body habitus, gait, skin color, nutritional status, respiratory effort, and specific anatomical regions. Requires adequate lighting and proper patient exposure.

### **Inspiratory Crackles**

Fine, discontinuous sounds heard during inspiration, caused by the sudden opening of collapsed airways. They are a hallmark of interstitial lung disease (bibasilar, Velcro-like crackles) and pulmonary fibrosis. They are also heard in pneumonia, atelectasis, and heart failure.

### **Instrument Sterilization**

A validated process that destroys all forms of microbial life, including bacterial spores, on or within a medical instrument. Common methods include steam under pressure, ethylene oxide, hydrogen-peroxide plasma, and dry heat, selected according to device material and design.

### **Instrumental Activities Of Daily Living**

More complex activities required for independent community living, including medication management, shopping, cooking, finances, communication,

transportation, and household tasks.

### **Instrumental ADL**

A complex activity needed for independent community living, such as shopping, cooking, managing medicines or finances, and using transportation.

### **Insufficient Cervix**

Painless cervical shortening and dilation during the second trimester, also called cervical insufficiency. It can cause recurrent mid-trimester pregnancy loss or spontaneous preterm birth without regular uterine contractions.

**Synonyms:**  
cervical insufficiency.

### **Insulin Aspart**

A rapid-acting insulin analog (modified amino acid sequence) with onset 10-20 minutes, peak 1-3 hours, duration 3-5 hours. Used to cover prandial glucose (injected at or just after meals) in type 1 and type 2 diabetes; also used in continuous subcutaneous insulin infusion (pump) and IV in acute settings.

### **Insulin Autoantibodies**

Autoantibodies directed against insulin or other pancreatic beta-cell antigens, including GAD, IA-2, and ZnT8 antibodies. Their presence supports autoimmune type 1 diabetes but a negative panel does not exclude it.

### **Insulin Glargine**

A long-acting basal insulin analog with a flat, peakless profile providing near-24-hour coverage, administered once daily (or twice in some patients). Formed by modification of human insulin producing slow, steady absorption from the injection depot. Used for type 1 and type 2 diabetes (basal component).

### **Insulin Injection Technique**

Insulin is injected into subcutaneous tissue using the prescribed device, dose, and site. Common sites include the abdomen, thighs, buttocks, and upper arms; rotating sites helps reduce lipohypertrophy and variable absorption. Technique should be indi-



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visualized to the person and device.

### **Insulin Lipohypertrophy**

Thickened fatty tissue at repeated insulin-injection sites. Injecting into these areas can make insulin absorption unpredictable.

### **Insulin Pen Devices**

Pre-filled or reusable insulin pen devices providing convenient and accurate insulin delivery. Benefits include portability precision dosing discrete injection and reduced needle phobia.

### **Insulin Preparations**

Hormone synthesized by pancreatic beta cells that regulates glucose homeostasis by promoting glucose uptake in skeletal muscle and adipose tissue, suppressing hepatic glucose production, and inhibiting lipolysis.

### **Insulin Pump Therapy**

Continuous subcutaneous insulin infusion delivering rapid-acting insulin analog through a catheter placed subcutaneously typically in the abdomen. Provides basal insulin at programmed rates and bolus doses at mealtimes.

### **Insulin Resistance**

Diminished biological response to physiological insulin concentrations resulting in impaired glucose disposal in peripheral tissues and failure to suppress hepatic glucose production. Pathophysiological hallmark of type two diabetes and metabolic syndrome.

#### **Synonyms:**

IR (Insulin Resistance)

### **Insulin Resistance Syndromes**

Rare inherited severe insulin resistance syndromes include Donohue syndrome also known as leprechaunism, Rabson-Mendenhall syndrome, and type A insulin resistance syndrome caused by mutations in the insulin receptor gene. Donohue syndrome is the most severe with death in infancy.

### **Insulin Secretion**

Release of insulin from pancreatic beta cells in response primarily to increased plasma glucose, with amplification by incretin hormones and nutrients. Insulin promotes glucose uptake, glycogen synthesis, lipogenesis, and protein synthesis while suppressing hepatic glucose production.

### **Insulin Signaling**

The cellular process initiated when insulin binds its receptor and activates pathways that regulate glucose uptake, glycogen formation, protein synthesis, and fat metabolism.

### **Insulin-Induced Lipohypertrophy**

A common complication of subcutaneous insulin therapy characterized by localized accumulation of adipose tissue at injection sites, caused by the lipogenic effect of insulin on subcutaneous fat. It presents as firm, rubbery, non-tender subcutaneous nodules that can cause unpredictable insulin absorption and glycemic variability.

### **Insulin-Like Growth Factor**

IGF-1 promotes growth. Produced in liver in response to GH.

### **Insulinoma**

An insulinoma is a usually benign pancreatic beta-cell neuroendocrine tumour that secretes excessive insulin, causing recurrent fasting or exertional hypoglycaemia relieved by glucose.

### **Integrative Rehabilitation**

Combination of conventional and complementary therapies: acupuncture, massage, yoga, meditation.

### **Integrans**

Genetic elements that capture and express gene cassettes through site-specific recombination. Integrans contain an integrase gene and a recombination site for gene cassette insertion. They are important vehicles for the spread of antibiotic resistance genes, particularly in gram-negative bacteria.



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## **Integumentary System**

The body system comprising the skin and its appendages: hair, nails, sweat glands, and sebaceous glands. It forms a protective barrier, limits fluid loss, contributes to thermoregulation and sensation, supports immune defence, and participates in vitamin D synthesis.

## **Intellectual Disability**

Neurodevelopmental disorder with onset in the developmental period, characterised by deficits in intellectual and adaptive functioning across conceptual, social, and practical domains. DSM-5 grades severity by adaptive functioning: mild, moderate, severe, profound.

## **Intensity-Modulated Radiation Therapy**

A computer-optimized form of three-dimensional radiation therapy that shapes and modulates the radiation dose to conform tightly to the target while sparing adjacent normal tissue.

## **Intensive Care Medicine**

Specialty managing critically ill patients. Components: monitoring, ventilatory support, hemodynamic support, infection control, nutrition, sedation, pain management. Common conditions: sepsis, ARDS, traumatic brain injury, post-cardiac arrest, multiorgan failure.

## **Intensive Care Rehabilitation**

Early rehabilitation in ICU setting. Early mobilization, positioning, passive range of motion. Improves outcomes, reduces complications.

## **Intensive Care Unit**

A specialist hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and life support for critically ill patients. In obstetrics, women may require ICU admission for: severe pre-eclampsia or eclampsia, massive postpartum hemorrhage, amniotic fluid embolism, sepsis, cardiac disease in pregnancy, or complications of anesthesia.

## **Interatrial Septum**

The wall separating the right and left atria. It

contains the fossa ovalis, a remnant of the foramen ovale from fetal circulation. The interatrial septum has a thinner area where transseptal puncture can be performed during cardiac catheterization.

## **Intercostal Retraction**

Inward movement of the skin and soft tissues between the ribs during inspiration, indicating increased work of breathing. It is common in infants and children with respiratory distress and may accompany airway obstruction, bronchiolitis, pneumonia, asthma, or other pulmonary disease.

## **Interdental Brush**

Small brush for cleaning between teeth. Used where spaces exist.

## **Interference**

A factor that alters the accuracy or interpretation of a laboratory test, measurement, or drug effect.

## **Interferon Signaling**

Type I IFN (IFN-alpha/beta): all nucleated cells produce; receptor IFNAR (ubiquitous); JAK1/TYK2 -> STAT1/2/IRF9 (ISGF3) -> ISGs (hundreds: antiviral, antiproliferative, immunomodulatory). Type II IFN (IFN-gamma): T/NK cells; receptor IFNGR; JAK1/JAK2 -> STAT1 -> GAS elements. Type III IFN (IFN-lambda): mucosal epithelium; receptor IFNLR.

## **Interferon-Gamma Release Assay**

Blood tests measuring IFN-gamma release in response to M. tuberculosis antigens (ESAT-6, CFP-10). More specific than PPD and unaffected by BCG. Cannot distinguish latent from active TB.

## **Interferonopathies**

A group of rare disorders caused by abnormal activation of type I interferon pathways. They can produce inflammation, neurologic disease, skin lesions, blood-vessel injury, or lung disease, often beginning in childhood.

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## Interleukin

A family of cytokines (interleukins) produced mainly by leukocytes that regulate immune cell growth, differentiation, activation, and communication. Examples: IL-1 and IL-6 (inflammation, fever), IL-2 (T-cell growth), IL-4/IL-13 (Th2, IgE), IL-5 (eosinophils), IL-10 (anti-inflammatory), IL-12 (Th1), IL-17 (Th17, autoimmunity), IL-23.

## Interleukin-6

A cytokine involved in immune regulation and inflammation that stimulates production of acute-phase proteins by the liver.

## Intermediate Cuneiform

Smallest cuneiform, centrally located between medial and lateral cuneiforms. Articulates with navicular, medial/lateral cuneiforms, and second metatarsal. Forms the transverse arch apex. Relatively fixed, contributing to midfoot stability. Injuries are typically associated with high-energy midfoot trauma.

## Intermediate Uveitis

Inflammation primarily affecting the vitreous body, peripheral retina, and ciliary body, with the classic presentation being pars planitis, which is characterized by the presence of snowbanking (a white, inflammatory exudate on the inferior pars plana) and snowballs (vitreous inflammatory aggregates).

## Intermittent Auscultation

Periodic assessment of the fetal heart rate with a fetoscope or Doppler device during labor rather than continuous electronic monitoring. The frequency of assessment depends on the stage of labor, risk factors, and local clinical protocol.

## Intermittent Claudication

Reproducible muscle discomfort, usually in the calf, thigh, or buttock, induced by walking and relieved by rest, caused by exertional arterial insufficiency. It is distinguished from rest pain and nonvascular musculoskeletal pain by history and vascular testing.

## Intermittent Explosive Disorder

A disorder characterized by recurrent, impulsive, problematic outbursts of verbal or physical aggression that are grossly disproportionate to the provocation. The outbursts are not premeditated and cause marked distress or functional impairment. Age >6 years.

### Synonyms:

Road Rage

## Intermittent Fasting

Cycling between fasting and eating periods. Methods: alternate-day fasting, 5:2 diet, time-restricted eating. Potential benefits: weight loss, metabolic health. Evidence emerging.

## Internal Hernia

Herniation of bowel through a mesenteric defect common after Roux-en-Y gastric bypass creating a defect at the jejunojejunostomy. May cause intermittent or acute small bowel obstruction. Presents with episodic abdominal pain, nausea, and vomiting.

## Internal Iliac Artery

Smaller common iliac terminal branch (hypogastric), supplying the pelvis, perineum, gluteal region, and medial thigh. Posterior division: iliolumbar, lateral sacral, superior gluteal. Anterior division: inferior gluteal, internal pudendal, obturator, vesical, uterine, vaginal, middle rectal arteries.

## Internal Jugular Vein

Descends in the carotid sheath with the internal carotid artery and vagus nerve, draining brain, face, and neck. Begins at the jugular foramen as a sigmoid sinus continuation, joining the subclavian vein to form the brachiocephalic vein. Contains backflow-preventing valves. Used for central venous catheterization.

## Internal Oblique Muscle

Middle flat abdominal layer deep to external oblique, from thoracolumbar fascia, iliac crest, and lateral inguinal ligament to lower ribs, linea alba, and pubic crest. Innervated by T7-T12 and L1. Ipsilateral rotation (opposite of external oblique). Contributes

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to inguinal canal and abdominal wall integrity.

### **Internal Podalic Version**

A maneuver where the operator inserts a hand into the uterus, grasps one or both fetal feet, and converts a transverse lie or cephalic presentation to a breech, then delivers by total breech extraction. Indication: delivery of the second twin (transverse lie) or severe fetal distress in the second stage. Rare in modern obstetrics.

### **Internal Resorption**

Loss of dentin from pulp cavity inward. Pink spot may be visible. Treatment: root canal therapy.

### **Internuclear Ophthalmoplegia**

A conjugate horizontal gaze disorder caused by a lesion of the medial longitudinal fasciculus (MLF), a heavily myelinated fiber tract that connects the abducens nucleus (CN VI) on one side to the oculomotor nucleus (CN III) on the contralateral side, coordinating horizontal gaze.

### **Interpersonal Psychotherapy**

A time-limited, evidence-based psychotherapy for depression that focuses on the interpersonal context of mood symptoms. It identifies four problem areas: grief, role disputes, role transitions, and interpersonal deficits. IPT helps patients improve interpersonal functioning and social support.

### **Interproximal Caries**

Dental caries occurring on the contact surfaces between adjacent teeth. It may be difficult to detect clinically and is commonly assessed with bitewing radiographs when imaging is indicated.

### **Interstitial (Cornual) Pregnancy**

An ectopic pregnancy implanted in the part of the fallopian tube that passes through the muscular wall of the uterus. It can enlarge before rupture and cause severe internal bleeding.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cornual

### **Interstitial Cystitis**

Chronic bladder pain syndrome. Symptoms: suprapubic pain, frequency, urgency. Diagnosis: exclusion, cystoscopy with hydrodistension. Treatment: lifestyle modification, medications, bladder instillations, surgery.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bladder Inflammation Cystitis, Interstitial IC (Interstitial Cystitis) Painful Bladder Syndrome

### **Interstitial Keratitis**

Inflammation of the corneal stroma without primary involvement of the corneal surface. It may follow infection, autoimmune disease, or trauma and can cause pain, photophobia, redness, and reduced vision.

### **Interstitial Lung Disease**

A heterogeneous group of disorders with inflammation and fibrosis of lung parenchyma, causing restrictive physiology (reduced FVC and TLC with normal or elevated FEV1/FVC ratio).

#### **Synonyms:**

Diffuse Parenchymal Lung Diseases Interstitial Lung Diseases Lung Disease, Interstitial

### **Interstitial Granulomatous Dermatitis**

A rare inflammatory dermatosis with interstitial or palisading histiocytes around collagen, often presenting with symmetric erythematous or violaceous plaques and associated systemic disease or medication exposure.

### **Interstitial Nephritis**

Inflammation of the renal interstitium and tubules, which can be acute or chronic. Acute interstitial nephritis is most commonly caused by medications, particularly NSAIDs, antibiotics including penicillins and cephalosporins, and proton pump inhibitors.

### **Interstitial Pneumonia**

Inflammation centered on the interstitium. Caused by Mycoplasma, Chlamydophila, Legionella, and viruses. Presents with dry cough and diffuse crackles.

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**Synonyms:**

Interstitial Lung Disease (Interstitial Pneumonia)

**Intertrigo**

Intertrigo is inflammation in opposing skin folds caused by moisture, heat, friction, and maceration; Candida or bacterial infection may complicate the tender erythematous rash.

**Synonyms:**

Allergy Diaper (Intertrigo)

**Interventional Procedures**

Image-guided treatments: angioplasty, stenting, embolization, ablation, biopsy, drain placement. Advantages: minimally invasive, faster recovery, lower complication rates.

**Interventional Radiologist**

A physician trained to perform minimally invasive diagnostic and therapeutic procedures using medical imaging for guidance.

**Interventional Radiology**

Image-guided minimally invasive procedures. Examples: angioplasty, stenting, embolization, biopsy, ablation, drain placement. Reduces need for open surgery.

**Interventricular Septum**

The thick muscular wall separating the left and right ventricles. It has two portions: the muscular (inferior, thicker) and membranous (superior, thinner) portions. The septum contains parts of the cardiac conduction system, including the bundle of His.

**Intervertebral Disc**

A fibrocartilaginous cushion between adjacent vertebral bodies, composed of a gelatinous nucleus pulposus surrounded by a tough annulus fibrosus. It absorbs shock and permits limited movement of the vertebral column.

**Intestinal Atresia**

A congenital obstruction of the small intestine (jejunum or ileum) caused by an intrauterine vascular

accident (mesenteric ischemia) leading to aseptic necrosis and resorption of a segment of bowel. In contrast to duodenal atresia, it is not associated with Down syndrome.

**Intestinal Ganglioneuromatosis**

Benign proliferation of ganglion cells and nerve fibers in the gastrointestinal tract wall. May be diffuse involving the entire gastrointestinal tract or localized as ganglioneuromas. Associated with multiple endocrine neoplasia type 2B where intestinal ganglioneuromatosis may precede the development of medullary thyroid carcinoma.

**Intestinal Lipomatosis**

Benign overgrowth of adipose tissue within the intestinal wall, most commonly affecting the ileum and colon. Often asymptomatic and discovered incidentally, but large lipomas can cause intussusception, gastrointestinal bleeding, or bowel obstruction.

**Intestinal Lymphoma**

Malignant proliferation of lymphoid cells arising in the small or large intestine. Important types include enteropathy-associated T-cell lymphoma, monomorphic epitheliotropic intestinal T-cell lymphoma, and diffuse large B-cell lymphoma.

**Intestinal Malrotation**

Congenital failure of normal midgut rotation and fixation, predisposing to a narrow mesenteric base, volvulus, and duodenal obstruction. Infants may present with bilious vomiting, abdominal distension, or bowel ischemia; sudden symptoms require emergency assessment.

**Intestinal Obstruction**

A mechanical or functional blockage that prevents normal passage of intestinal contents. Causes include adhesions, hernias, tumors, inflammation, volvulus, and disorders of intestinal motility.

**Intestinal Perforation**

Full-thickness breach in the bowel wall allowing luminal contents to enter the peritoneal cavity. Causes include diverticulitis, appendicitis, peptic ulcer dis-

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ease, and trauma. Presents with acute abdomen, peritonitis, and free air on imaging.

### **Intestinal Pseudo-Obstruction**

Acute or chronic dilation of the bowel without mechanical obstruction due to neuromuscular dysfunction. Acute colonic pseudo-obstruction also called Ogilvie syndrome occurs in hospitalized or post-surgical patients.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ogilvie syndrome.

### **Intimal Hyperplasia**

Proliferation and migration of vascular smooth-muscle cells with extracellular-matrix deposition within the intima after vascular injury or graft placement. It can produce restenosis at anastomoses, stents, dialysis access, or bypass grafts.

### **Intimate Partner Violence In Pregnancy**

Physical, sexual, or psychological abuse by a current or former partner during pregnancy. It can harm the pregnant person and fetus and is associated with complications such as injury, preterm birth, and placental abruption.

### **Intoxication**

A state of physical or mental impairment caused by recent exposure to a substance, such as alcohol, a medicine, or another drug.

### **Intra-Abdominal Abscess**

Localized collection of pus within the abdomen commonly in the pelvis, between bowel loops, or beneath the diaphragm. Results from intra-abdominal infection or surgery. Presents with fever, abdominal pain, and leukocytosis. Diagnosed by CT with contrast showing rim-enhancing fluid collection.

### **Intra-Abdominal Hypertension**

Sustained elevation of intra-abdominal pressure above twelve millimeters of mercury measured through the urinary bladder. Graded as grade one twelve to fifteen, grade two sixteen to twenty, grade three twenty-one to twenty-five, and grade four greater than twenty-five millimeters of mercury.

### **Intra-Aortic Balloon Pump**

Mechanical circulatory support. Inflatable catheter in descending aorta. Inflates during diastole (increases coronary perfusion), deflates during systole (reduces afterload). Indications: cardiogenic shock, unstable angina, high-risk PCI. Complications: limb ischemia, bleeding, infection.

### **Intraabdominal Cancer**

A broad term for malignancies arising within the abdominal cavity, including cancers of the colon, stomach, pancreas, liver, ovaries, and peritoneum. Presentation varies widely depending on the specific organ involved.

### **Intraabdominal Hernia**

Herniation of abdominal viscera through a congenital or acquired defect or abnormal mesenteric aperture within the peritoneal cavity, distinct from ventral or inguinal hernias. Types include paraduodenal, foramen of Winslow, transmesocolic, and transomental hernias.

### **Intracellular Fluid**

The fluid contained within cells, comprising approximately two thirds of total body water in a typical adult. Its major solutes include potassium, magnesium, phosphate, and intracellular proteins, and its composition is maintained by selective membrane transport.

### **Intracellular Pathogens**

Microorganisms that survive and replicate within host cells. Intracellular bacteria include *Mycobacterium*, *Listeria*, and *Chlamydia*. Viruses are obligate intracellular pathogens. Intracellular survival protects pathogens from antibiotics and immune responses.

### **Intracerebral Hemorrhage**

Bleeding directly into the brain parenchyma, accounting for approximately ten to fifteen percent of all strokes and carrying a high mortality rate of approximately forty percent at thirty days.



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### **Intracranial Hemorrhage**

Bleeding within the cranial cavity. Epidural hematoma: arterial bleeding (middle meningeal artery), typically from temporal bone fracture; lucid interval then rapid deterioration. Subdural hematoma: venous bleeding from bridging veins; acute (<72h), subacute, or chronic (elderly, alcoholics).

### **Intracranial Pressure**

The pressure within the cranial vault generated by brain tissue, cerebrospinal fluid, and intracranial blood. Sustained elevation can reduce cerebral perfusion and cause headache, vomiting, altered consciousness, pupillary abnormalities, and brain herniation.

### **Intraductal Papilloma**

A benign papillary tumor arising within a breast duct, often presenting with spontaneous unilateral bloody or clear nipple discharge. It may be solitary near the nipple or multiple in the peripheral breast.

### **Intrahepatic Cholestasis Of Pregnancy**

A pregnancy-associated liver disorder characterized mainly by itching without a primary rash and increased bile acids in the blood. It may increase fetal risk and requires clinical evaluation and monitoring.

### **Intramedullary Nail**

A metal implant inserted into the medullary canal of a long bone to align and stabilize a fracture. It shares load along the bone axis and is commonly used for femoral and tibial shaft fractures.

### **Intramural Hematoma**

Collection of blood within the wall of the gastrointestinal tract most commonly the duodenum. Caused by trauma, anticoagulation, or coagulopathy. Presents with abdominal pain, vomiting, and sometimes obstructive symptoms. Diagnosis is by CT showing circumferential wall thickening with high-attenuation hematoma.

### **Intramuscular**

A route of drug administration in which the drug is

injected into skeletal muscle (deltoid, vastus lateralis, gluteus maximus).

### **Intraocular Lens**

Artificial lens replacing natural lens after cataract extraction. Types: monofocal (distance vision), multifocal/bifocal (near and distance), toric (astigmatism), extended depth of focus. Implantation via small incision, folds for insertion. Complications: posterior capsule opacification, dysphotopsia, infection, retinal detachment.

### **Intraocular Lens Dislocation**

Postoperative displacement of an implanted artificial intraocular lens from its intended position within the capsular bag or ciliary sulcus into the vitreous cavity or anterior chamber. It is most commonly caused by progressive zonular dehiscence and may require surgical repositioning or exchange.

### **Intraocular Pressure**

The pressure generated by aqueous humor within the eye, normally maintained by a balance between aqueous production and outflow. Abnormal IOP is an important risk factor for glaucomatous optic neuropathy, but glaucoma can occur at statistically normal pressures.

### **Intraocular Tumor**

Any neoplasm arising within the eye, with uveal melanoma being the most common primary malignancy in adults and retinoblastoma the most common in children. Diagnosis requires dilated fundus examination, ultrasound, and MRI; treatment depends on tumour type, size, and location.

### **Intraoperative Blood Transfusion**

Intraoperative blood transfusion replaces lost blood volume and maintains oxygen-carrying capacity during major surgery. Indications include hemoglobin less than 7 g/dL in stable patients, less than 8 g/dL in cardiac disease, or active hemorrhage with hemodynamic instability.

### **Intraoperative Neuromonitoring**

Intraoperative neuromonitoring (IONM) uses elec-



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trophysiological techniques to monitor neural pathway integrity during surgery. Somatosensory evoked potentials (SSEP) monitor sensory pathways. Motor evoked potentials (MEP) monitor motor pathways. Electromyography (EMG) monitors cranial nerves and spinal roots.

### **Intraosseous Access**

Placement of a vascular-access needle into the medullary cavity of a suitable bone to permit rapid infusion of fluids, blood products, and medications when intravenous access is delayed or impossible. It is a temporary emergency route and can cause extravasation, infection, or compartment injury.

### **Intraosseous Infusion**

Administration of fluids, blood products, or medications through an intraosseous access device. Infusion should be monitored for resistance, swelling, pain, and extravasation and replaced with definitive vascular access as soon as practical.

### **Intrapartum**

The period during labor and childbirth, from the onset of regular uterine contractions leading to cervical dilation until delivery of the baby and placenta.

### **Intrapulmonary Shunt**

Perfusion of alveoli without ventilation ( $V/Q = 0$ ). Blood passes through the pulmonary circulation without gas exchange, mixing with oxygenated blood and causing hypoxemia. It is seen in ARDS, pneumonia, and atelectasis. It is refractory to supplemental oxygen.

### **Intrathecal Chemotherapy**

Administration of chemotherapy directly into the cerebrospinal fluid via lumbar puncture or an Ommaya reservoir, used for leptomeningeal metastasis and central nervous system prophylaxis in leukemias and lymphomas.

### **Intrathoracic Localized Obstruction**

A focal blockage within the thoracic cavity affecting the airways, esophagus, or great vessels, leading to localized symptoms depending on the structure

involved. Causes include endobronchial tumors, foreign bodies, esophageal strictures, or vascular anomalies. Diagnosis is by imaging and endoscopy.

### **Intrauterine Device**

IUD: a long-acting reversible contraceptive (LARC) device placed in the uterus. Types: copper IUD (ParaGard—hormone-free, up to 10-12 years, also emergency contraception) and levonorgestrel-releasing IUS (Mirena/Skyla—progestin, up to 3-8 years, reduces bleeding).

### **Intrauterine Fetal Demise / Stillbirth**

Death of a fetus before complete delivery. The gestational-age definition varies by jurisdiction. Causes may include placental disease, umbilical-cord complications, infection, genetic abnormalities, maternal disease, or unexplained factors.

### **Intrauterine Growth Restriction**

IUGR: a fetus with estimated weight below the 10th percentile (or growth velocity decline), usually with placental insufficiency or maternal/fetal factors.

### **Intrauterine Pressure Catheter**

A fluid-filled catheter inserted into the uterine cavity alongside the fetus to measure the intensity and frequency of contractions in mm Hg (Montevideo units, MVU).

### **Intrauterine Transfusion**

Ultrasonically guided intravascular or intraperitoneal transfusion of fetal red blood cells to treat severe fetal anemia, most commonly from Rh isoimmunization. Performed through the umbilical vein using a 22-25 gauge needle. Packed red blood cells, CMV-negative and crossmatched, are transfused slowly.

### **Intravascular Catheter Infections**

CLABSI: central line-associated bloodstream infection. Diagnosis: quantitative blood cultures (catheter vs peripheral  $>5:1$ ), differential time to positivity ( $>2h$ ), catheter tip culture ( $>15$  CFU). Catheter-related BSIs: coagulase-negative staphylococci (most common), *S. aureus*, enterococci, gram-

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negatives, *Candida*.

### **Intravascular Filter**

A device placed in a large vein to trap venous clots and reduce pulmonary embolism risk in selected patients who cannot receive or have not responded adequately to anticoagulation.

### **Intravascular Lymphoma**

A rare aggressive B-cell non-Hodgkin lymphoma characterized by proliferation of neoplastic lymphocytes within the lumina of small blood vessels, predominantly affecting the skin and central nervous system. Presents with livedo reticularis, skin nodules, neurological deficits, and fever of unknown origin.

### **Intravascular Ultrasound**

Catheter-based imaging using a miniature ultrasound probe inside coronary arteries to visualize vessel wall layers, plaque composition, and stent deployment. Provides more detailed information than angiography alone, including vessel remodeling, plaque burden, and true vessel diameter.

### **Intravenous Anesthesia**

Anesthetic induction or maintenance using drugs delivered into a vein. It permits rapid titration but requires attention to dose, context-sensitive recovery, cardiovascular and respiratory effects, and the availability of a secure airway.

### **Intravenous Lipid Emulsion Therapy**

Administration of a lipid emulsion as a rescue treatment for selected severe lipophilic drug toxicities, especially local-anesthetic systemic toxicity. It may act as a lipid sink and through metabolic and cardiovascular effects and requires critical-care monitoring.

### **Intravenous Pyelogram**

A clinical condition or finding involving intravenous pyelogram. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context. of iodinated contrast material. The contrast is filtered by the glomeruli and excreted through the

collecting system, allowing sequential imaging of the renal parenchyma, calyces, renal pelvis, ureters, and bladder.

### **Intraventricular Hemorrhage**

Bleeding into the germinal matrix and ventricular system, primarily in premature infants less than 32 weeks gestation. Graded I-IV by severity on cranial ultrasound. Grade I (germinal matrix only) and Grade II (intraventricular without dilation) have good prognosis.

### **Intravitreal Injection**

An ophthalmological procedure in which medication is injected directly into the vitreous cavity of the eye through the pars plana, a safe entry zone located approximately 3.5 to 4 millimeters posterior to the limbus, to deliver therapeutic agents directly to the retina and vitreous for the treatment of various retinal diseases.

### **Intrinsic Renal AKI**

Acute kidney injury caused by damage to renal tissue. Causes include acute tubular injury, acute interstitial nephritis, glomerulonephritis, and vascular disorders. Laboratory findings vary with the cause and should not be interpreted in isolation.

### **Intron**

A non-coding segment of a gene that is transcribed into RNA but spliced out before the messenger RNA is translated into a protein.

### **Intussusception**

Condition in which a segment of intestine telescopes into the adjacent distal segment causing bowel obstruction and compromise of the mesenteric blood supply. It is the most common cause of intestinal obstruction in infants and children between six months and three years of age.

### **Invasive Candidiasis**

A serious *Candida* infection that enters the bloodstream or deep organs, most often in people who are critically ill or immunocompromised. It may cause persistent fever or organ dysfunction and requires

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prompt medical diagnosis and treatment.

### **Invasive Ductal Carcinoma**

The most common type of breast cancer, characterized by malignant cells that have broken through the duct wall and invaded surrounding breast tissue. It can metastasize via lymphatic or hematogenous spread.

### **Invasive Lobular Carcinoma**

A breast cancer characterized by discohesive cells infiltrating in single-file lines. More frequently bilateral and multifocal than ductal carcinoma and harder to detect on imaging; usually hormone receptor positive.

### **Inverse Agonist**

A type of drug that binds to a cell receptor and actively produces the opposite biological effect of an agonist, effectively turning down the receptor's baseline activity.

### **Inversion**

Chromosomal segment reversed end-to-end. Paracentric: does not include centromere. Pericentric: includes centromere. Usually benign unless breakpoint disrupts gene.

### **Involuntary Psychiatric Treatment**

Assessment, hospitalization, or treatment without the patient's consent under applicable law when serious mental disorder creates a substantial risk of harm or severe inability to meet basic needs. The least restrictive alternative, due process, and ongoing reassessment are required.

### **Involution**

The process by which the uterus returns to its prepregnancy size after delivery. The uterus weighs approximately 1000 grams immediately postpartum and returns to approximately 60 grams by 6 weeks. Fundal height decreases approximately 1 cm per day.

### **Iodide-Associated Sialadenitis**

Inflammation and swelling of the salivary glands caused by excessive iodide intake, typically from medications such as amiodarone or iodine-containing contrast, resolving with dose reduction.

### **Iodinated Contrast Media**

Contrast agents containing iodine used primarily for radiography, CT, angiography, and some fluoroscopic procedures. Important risks include immediate hypersensitivity-like reactions, extravasation, thyroid effects, and kidney injury in susceptible patients.

### **Iodine**

Required for thyroid hormones. Deficiency: goiter, hypothyroidism, cretinism. Prevention: iodized salt, seafood. Excess can cause thyroid dysfunction.

### **Iodine-123**

Pure gamma emitter, half-life 13 hours. Used for thyroid imaging. No beta emission, lower radiation dose than I-131.

### **Iodine-131**

A radioactive iodine isotope used in selected diagnostic and therapeutic procedures, especially for thyroid disease.

### **Iododerma**

A papulopustular or acneiform skin eruption caused by iodine excess, presenting on the face and extensor surfaces, resolving with iodine restriction and symptomatic treatment.

### **Ionizing Radiation**

Radiation with enough energy to remove electrons from atoms and create ions, including X-rays, gamma rays, and certain particulate emissions. It can cause deterministic tissue effects at sufficient doses and stochastic cancer risk at lower doses.

### **Ipecac**

Emetic no longer recommended for routine poisoning management. Risk of aspiration, delays charcoal

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administration.

### **Ipratropium Bromide**

An inhaled anticholinergic (antimuscarinic) bronchodilator that blocks acetylcholine at airway smooth muscle muscarinic receptors. It reduces bronchospasm and mucus secretion. It is used in COPD and acute asthma exacerbations. It is less effective than beta-2 agonists in asthma but more effective in COPD.

### **Ipsilateral**

Located on the same side of the body.

### **Iridocyclitis**

Inflammation involving the iris and ciliary body, a form of anterior uveitis. It may cause eye pain, photophobia, redness, blurred vision, and cells or flare in the anterior chamber and may be associated with autoimmune disease, infection, trauma, or other causes.

### **Iridotomy**

A procedure that creates a small opening in the iris to allow aqueous humor to pass between the posterior and anterior chambers. Laser peripheral iridotomy is used to treat or prevent selected forms of angle-closure glaucoma.

### **Iris**

The iris is the coloured muscular diaphragm between the cornea and lens that controls pupil diameter and regulates the amount of light entering the eye. light entry. Two muscles: sphincter pupillae (parasympathetic CN III, constricts in bright light) and dilator pupillae (sympathetic, dilates in darkness). Iris root attaches to the ciliary body.

### **Iris Atrophy**

Thinning or loss of iris tissue resulting from trauma, chronic inflammation, ischaemia, or neurodegenerative disease, leading to a translucent or patched iris appearance. It may be sectoral or diffuse and can be associated with decreased pupillary response, photophobia, or secondary glaucoma.

### **Iritis**

Inflammation of the iris, the most common form of anterior uveitis. Presents with acute onset eye pain, photophobia, blurred vision, and redness (ciliary flush). Signs: cells and flare in the anterior chamber, keratic precipitates (KP), synechiae (adhesions between iris and lens).

### **Iron**

Essential for hemoglobin, myoglobin, and electron transport. Heme iron from animal foods is generally more bioavailable than non-heme iron from plant foods. Deficiency is the most common nutritional deficiency worldwide and may result from blood loss, increased requirements, poor intake, or malabsorption.

### **Iron Deficiency**

The most common nutritional deficiency worldwide, resulting from inadequate iron intake, impaired absorption, or chronic blood loss, leading to reduced hemoglobin synthesis and microcytic hypochromic anemia. Clinical features include fatigue, pallor, koilonychia, pica, and angular cheilitis.

### **Iron Deficiency Anemia**

Anemia caused by insufficient iron for hemoglobin production. It is often microcytic and hypochromic; treatment requires identifying the cause and replacing iron when appropriate.

### **Iron-Deficiency Anemia**

Anemia caused by insufficient iron for normal hemoglobin production. It may cause fatigue, weakness, shortness of breath, paleness, headache, or unusual cravings such as ice; the cause of iron loss or inadequate intake should be identified.

### **Iron-Deficiency Anaemia In Adolescents**

Iron-deficiency anaemia during adolescence, commonly related to rapid growth, inadequate dietary iron, or menstrual blood loss. Assessment should identify the cause and guide dietary advice and clinical treatment.

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## **Irregular Sleep-Wake Syndrome**

A circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorder with multiple irregular periods of sleep and wakefulness across the 24-hour day rather than one consolidated nighttime sleep period. It is associated with neurological disease, dementia, aging, and reduced exposure to environmental time cues.

## **Irreversible Cell Injury**

Cell damage beyond the point of recovery, resulting in death by necrosis, apoptosis, or another regulated cell-death pathway. Key features include inability to reverse mitochondrial dysfunction and severe membrane or nuclear damage.

## **Irritable Bowel Syndrome**

A chronic functional gastrointestinal disorder characterized by recurrent abdominal pain and altered bowel habits (diarrhea, constipation, or mixed) without identifiable structural pathology. Pathophysiology involves dysregulation of the gut-brain axis, visceral hypersensitivity, altered motility, and imbalances in the gut microbiome.

### **Synonyms:**

IBS

## **Irritable Bowel Syndrome Diet**

An individualized eating plan used to reduce irritable bowel syndrome symptoms. A limited trial of a low-FODMAP diet may help some people and should be followed by structured food reintroduction.

## **Isaacs Syndrome**

A rare peripheral nerve hyperexcitability disorder causing continuous muscle-fibre activity, stiffness, cramps, fasciculations, myokymia, and delayed muscle relaxation. It may be autoimmune, paraneoplastic, or associated with inherited or acquired peripheral-nerve disorders.

## **Isavuconazole**

A triazole antifungal agent used in the treatment of invasive aspergillosis and mucormycosis. Isavuconazole inhibits fungal lanosterol 14- $\alpha$  demethylase, disrupting ergosterol synthesis and fungal cell mem-

brane integrity.

## **Ischemia**

Reduced blood flow causing oxygen deprivation. Can lead to tissue damage or death.

## **Ischemia-Reperfusion Injury**

The paradoxical tissue damage that occurs when blood flow is restored to previously ischemic tissue, a phenomenon with major clinical significance in myocardial infarction treatment, stroke management, organ transplantation, and shock resuscitation.

## **Ischemic Cardiomyopathy**

Weakening of the heart muscle caused by coronary artery disease and previous or ongoing myocardial ischemia. Scarred or poorly perfused myocardium can reduce contractile function and increase the risk of heart failure and ventricular arrhythmias.

## **Ischemic Colitis**

Colonic mucosal ischemia resulting from reduced blood flow through the marginal artery and end-arteries, most commonly occurring at watershed areas between vascular territories, particularly the splenic flexure.

### **Synonyms:**

Colitis, Ischemic

## **Ischemic Gangrene**

Death of tissue due to prolonged severe arterial insufficiency, most commonly in the extremities. Presents as dry, black, mummified tissue with a clear line of demarcation from viable tissue. Requires revascularization when possible and surgical debridement or amputation of necrotic tissue.

## **Ischemic Stroke**

A neurologic deficit caused by inadequate blood flow to part of the brain, usually from thrombotic or embolic arterial occlusion. Causes include atherosclerotic disease, cardiac embolism, and small-vessel disease.



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## Ischium

Inferior-posterior hip bone. Ischial tuberosity bears seated weight and serves as hamstring attachment. Ischial spine is a pudendal nerve block landmark and determines pelvic outlet level. Lesser sciatic notch lies between spine and tuberosity.

## Isocitrate Dehydrogenase

A regulated enzyme of the citric acid cycle that converts isocitrate to alpha-ketoglutarate while producing NADH and releasing carbon dioxide. Mitochondrial isoforms are stimulated by ADP and calcium and inhibited by ATP and NADH. Mutations in IDH1 or IDH2 can produce the oncometabolite 2-hydroxyglutarate.

## Isokinetic Exercise

Muscle contraction at constant speed throughout range of motion. Uses specialized equipment. Assesses and improves strength.

## Isolation

Separation of sick persons with contagious disease. Examples: tuberculosis isolation, airborne infection isolation rooms.

## Isolation (Social)

Lack of social contacts and interactions. Common in elderly: bereavement, mobility limitation, sensory impairment, retirement. Consequences: depression, cognitive decline, functional impairment, mortality. Interventions: social programs, transportation, technology, volunteer visits.

### Synonyms:

Social

## Isolation Precautions

Measures used with standard precautions to reduce transmission of infection. Additional precautions may be contact, droplet, or airborne, depending on the mode of spread.

## Isoniazid Toxicity

Hepatotoxicity, peripheral neuropathy, seizures. Treatment: pyridoxine (vitamin B6) supplementa-

tion, activated charcoal, seizure control.

## Isosorbide Dinitrate

An organic nitrate (and prodrug) that releases nitric oxide, relaxing vascular smooth muscle—predominantly venous (preload reduction) with coronary dilation.

## Isosporiasis

Intestinal infection caused by the protozoan *Cystoisospora belli*. It typically causes watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, fever, and weight loss and may be prolonged or severe in people with impaired cellular immunity.

## Isotope

One of two or more atoms of the same element with the same number of protons but different numbers of neutrons.

## Isotretinoin

A systemic retinoid used for severe, recalcitrant nodular acne. It reduces sebum production, normalizes follicular keratinization, decreases *Propionibacterium acnes*, and has anti-inflammatory effects. Dose is 0.5 to 1 mg/kg/day for 15 to 20 weeks, targeting cumulative dose of 120 to 150 mg/kg.

## Itching

Itching, or pruritus, is an unpleasant sensation that provokes scratching and may arise from skin disease, allergy, systemic illness, medications, neuropathy, or psychogenic factors. It can be acute or chronic and may arise from skin disease, systemic illness, medication, or neuropathic mechanisms.

## Iterative Reconstruction

Modern reconstruction method. OSEM (Ordered Subsets Expectation Maximization). Better quality, longer computation.

## IV Fluids

Intravenous fluid therapy for volume resuscitation and maintenance. Crystalloids: normal saline (0.9% NaCl, increases chloride, risk of hyperchloremic



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metabolic acidosis), lactated Ringer (balanced, contains K<sup>+</sup>, Ca<sup>2+</sup>, lactate buffer, safer in large volumes), Plasma-Lyte (balanced, closest to plasma).

### **IVC Filter**

Device placed in inferior vena cava to prevent pulmonary embolism. Indications: DVT/PE with contraindication to anticoagulation, recurrent PE despite anticoagulation. Complications: filter thrombosis, migration, perforation, IVC occlusion.

### **IVF**

In vitro fertilization: the assisted reproductive technology in which oocytes are retrieved, fertilized by sperm outside the body (in vitro), and the resulting embryos transferred to the uterus. Indications: tubal factor, male factor (with ICSI), endometriosis, unexplained, ovulation disorders, genetic testing, and same-sex couples or individuals using donor sperm or eggs.

### **Immunoglobulin**

An antibody protein produced by immune cells to recognize and help neutralize foreign substances.

### **Immunosuppressant Drug**

A medicine that reduces immune-system activity, often to prevent transplant rejection or treat autoimmune disease.

### **Impaired Fasting Glucose**

Blood glucose above the normal range after fasting but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes.

### **Impaired Glucose Tolerance**

Blood glucose above the normal range after a glucose challenge but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes.

### **Infarct**

An area of dead tissue caused by inadequate blood supply.

### **Islets Of Langerhans**

Clusters of endocrine cells in the pancreas that pro-

duce hormones including insulin and glucagon.

### **Iliac Artery**

An artery that supplies blood to the pelvis and lower limb.

### **Immunoglobulin A**

An antibody found mainly in mucosal secretions, including saliva, tears, and intestinal fluid.

### **Immunoglobulin G**

The most abundant antibody in blood, providing long-lasting protection against many infections.

### **Immunoglobulin M**

The first major antibody produced during an initial immune response.

### **Infectious Encephalitis**

Inflammation of the brain caused by an infectious organism, most often a virus.

### **Intracranial Aneurysm**

A weakened, bulging area in a blood vessel within the skull.

### **Intrahepatic Cholestasis**

Impaired bile flow within the liver, causing bile acids to accumulate in the blood.

### **Impacted Wisdom Teeth**

Wisdom teeth that cannot emerge normally because they are blocked by bone, gum, or another tooth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Wisdom Teeth, Impacted

### **Incompetent Cervix**

Early painless opening of the cervix during pregnancy, which may lead to pregnancy loss or premature birth.

### **Infant Jaundice**

Yellowing of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by excess bilirubin in the blood.

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### **Infant Reflux**

Backflow of stomach contents into an infant's esophagus, often causing spitting up.

### **Inflammatory Breast Cancer**

A rare, rapidly progressing breast cancer that causes redness, swelling, and skin thickening.

#### **Synonyms:**

Breast Cancer, Inflammatory Cancer, Inflammatory Breast

### **Ingrown Hair**

A hair that curls back into the skin or grows sideways, causing an inflamed bump.

### **Intestinal Ischemia**

Inadequate blood flow to the intestines, which can damage intestinal tissue.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ischemia, Intestinal

### **Intracranial Venous Malformations**

Abnormal collections or connections of veins within the skull that may bleed or affect nearby brain tissue.

### **Icterus**

Yellow discoloration of the skin or eyes caused by excess bilirubin; also called jaundice.

#### **Synonyms:**

jaundice.

### **Ictus**

A sudden neurological event, such as a stroke or seizure.

### **Ileal Conduit**

A surgically created passage that diverts urine through a segment of ileum to an opening in the abdominal wall.

### **Infectious Mononucleosis**

A viral illness, usually caused by Epstein-Barr virus, characterized by fatigue, sore throat, and swollen lymph nodes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mono (Infectious Mononucleosis)

### **Insertion**

Movement of a muscle attachment toward its fixed attachment, or placement of one structure into another.

### **Inspiration**

The act of breathing air into the lungs.

### **Intubation**

Placement of a tube into the airway or another body passage to maintain it or deliver treatment.

### **Iontophoresis**

A chemical substance or compound called iontophoresis. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Immunity**

The ability of the body to recognize and resist infectious agents or other foreign substances through innate or adaptive defenses.

### **Immunology**

The medical and biological study of the immune system, immune responses, and immune disorders.

### **Immunosuppression**

Reduction of immune-system activity, caused by disease or intentionally induced with medications or other treatment.

### **Injection**

Introduction of a medication, fluid, or other substance into the body with a needle or other injection device.

### **Insulin Shock**

Severe hypoglycemia, historically associated with excessive insulin and characterized by confusion, seizures, loss of consciousness, or other neurologic dysfunction.

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### **Interneurons**

Neurons within the central nervous system that connect other neurons and help process or coordinate neural signals.

### **Intraaortic Balloon Pump**

A temporary circulatory-support device with a balloon in the descending aorta that inflates and deflates in coordination with the cardiac cycle.

### **Intravenous Pyelography**

An X-ray examination of the urinary tract after intravenous contrast administration; it is now often replaced by CT urography or ultrasound.

### **Intrinsic Factor**

A protein secreted by stomach parietal cells that is required for vitamin B12 absorption in the terminal ileum.

### **In Vitro Fertilization**

A fertility treatment in which an egg and sperm are combined in a laboratory and a resulting embryo is transferred to the uterus.

### **Irrigation**

Flushing a wound, body cavity, or organ with fluid to remove blood, debris, microorganisms, or unwanted material.

### **Isometric**

Describing muscle contraction that produces force without a meaningful change in muscle length or joint movement.

### **Isotonic**

Describing muscle contraction in which muscle length changes to move a joint under a relatively constant external load.

### **Impingement Syndrome**

Pain and restricted movement caused when a tendon or other soft tissue is compressed between bones, commonly in the shoulder during elevation of the arm.

### **Incarcerated Hernia**

A hernia whose protruded tissue cannot be returned to the abdominal cavity. It may progress to strangulation and requires urgent clinical assessment.

### **Impacted Fracture**

A fracture in which one broken bone fragment is driven firmly into another, often producing relative stability but sometimes causing shortening or deformity.

### **Infantile Spasms**

A severe seizure disorder of infancy characterized by brief, sudden flexion or extension spasms, often occurring in clusters and associated with developmental impairment.

### **Iodine Deficiency**

Inadequate iodine intake or availability, which can impair thyroid-hormone production and cause goiter, hypothyroidism, or developmental problems in a fetus or child.

### **Intestinal Metaplasia**

Replacement of the normal lining of an intestinal or gastric region by intestinal-type epithelium, usually in response to chronic injury or inflammation and sometimes associated with increased cancer risk.

### **Irritant Contact Dermatitis**

Inflammation of the skin caused by direct chemical or physical injury rather than an immune-mediated allergy. It commonly produces redness, burning, scaling, fissures, or pain at the area of exposure.

### **Isolated Systolic Hypertension**

Elevated systolic blood pressure with normal diastolic pressure, commonly related to arterial stiffness in older adults and associated with increased cardiovascular risk.

### **Immersion Foot (Trench Foot)**

A painful cold injury caused by prolonged exposure of the feet to cold, wet conditions without freezing, leading to numbness, swelling, and skin changes.

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**Synonyms:**  
Trench Foot

### **Incompetence**

Failure of a structure to close or function adequately; examples include valvular incompetence of the heart and cervical incompetence during pregnancy.

### **Incoordination (Ataxia)**

Impaired coordination of voluntary movement, often caused by disease affecting the cerebellum or other parts of the nervous system.

**Synonyms:**  
Ataxia

### **Incisor**

One of the front teeth, adapted mainly for cutting or biting food.

### **Incision**

A deliberate surgical cut made into the skin or other tissue.

### **Infant Mortality**

The death of an infant before the first birthday; the infant mortality rate is usually expressed per 1,000 live births.

### **Infestation**

The presence or invasion of parasitic organisms, such as lice, mites, or worms, on or in the body.

### **Innervation**

The nerve supply to an organ, muscle, or area of the body, including the functional control provided by those nerves.

### **Internal Capsule**

A compact band of white-matter nerve fibres in the brain carrying important motor and sensory pathways between the cerebral cortex and lower centres.

### **Intestine**

The part of the digestive tract extending from the

stomach to the anus, consisting of the small intestine and large intestine.

### **Introitus**

An entrance or opening, especially the entrance to the vagina.

### **Involuntary Muscle**

Muscle that contracts without conscious control, including smooth muscle in internal organs and cardiac muscle in the heart.

### **Iron-Deficiency Anaemia**

Anaemia caused by insufficient iron for haemoglobin production, commonly due to blood loss, inadequate intake, or impaired absorption.

### **Ischaemia**

Inadequate blood flow and oxygen delivery to a tissue, usually because of narrowed or blocked blood vessels, causing dysfunction or injury.

### **Ischaemic Heart Disease (IHD)**

Heart disease caused by reduced blood supply to the heart muscle, usually as a result of coronary artery disease; it may cause angina or myocardial infarction.

### **Iatrogenic Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving iatrogenic disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ibandronic Acid**

ibandronic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Ibogaine**

Ibogaine is a psychoactive plant alkaloid studied for addiction treatment but associated with dangerous cardiac arrhythmias, seizures, and death.

### **Ibritumomab Tiuxetan**

A medicine or chemical compound called ibritu-

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momab tiuxetan. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Ibuprofen**

Ibuprofen is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug that inhibits cyclo-oxygenase and reduces pain, fever, and inflammation; gastrointestinal bleeding, renal injury, fluid retention, and cardiovascular risks limit use in some patients.

### **Icteric Index**

The icteric index is a laboratory estimate of serum yellow discoloration related mainly to bilirubin and can signal jaundice or interfere with testing.

### **Idarubicin**

Idarubicin is an anthracycline chemotherapy drug that intercalates DNA and inhibits topoisomerase II, used mainly in acute myeloid leukaemia; myelosuppression and cumulative cardiotoxicity are important risks.

### **Idoxuridine**

Idoxuridine is a thymidine analogue antiviral formerly used mainly topically for herpes simplex keratitis; it inhibits viral DNA synthesis but can irritate or damage the corneal epithelium.

### **Ifosfamide**

Ifosfamide is an alkylating chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used for selected sarcomas and other cancers; haemorrhagic cystitis, encephalopathy, infertility, and myelosuppression require monitoring and mesna protection.

### **Igh Gene**

igh gene is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Ikappab Kinase**

I $\kappa$ B kinase is an enzyme complex that activates NF- $\kappa$ B signaling by phosphorylating its inhibitor and regulating inflammation and immune gene expres-

sion.

### **Ileal Fistula**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileal fistula. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ileal Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ileal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving ileal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Ileal Stenosis**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileal stenosis. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ileal Ulcer**

An ileal ulcer is a break in the lining of the ileum caused by inflammation, infection, medicines, ischemia, trauma, or another intestinal disorder.

### **Iliac Crest**

The iliac crest is the curved upper border of the ilium and a landmark and attachment site for abdominal, back, and pelvic muscles.

### **Iliac Vein**

An iliac vein drains blood from the pelvis and lower limb toward the inferior vena cava; thrombosis can cause swelling and pulmonary embolism.

### **Illusion**

A chemical substance or compound called illusion. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Iloprost**

A clinical condition or finding involving iloprost. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and manage-

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ment depend on the clinical context.

### **Image View**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to image view. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Imaging Technique**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to imaging technique. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Imatinib Mesylate**

A clinical condition or finding involving imatinib mesylate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Imide**

An imide is a chemical compound containing nitrogen bonded to two carbonyl groups and may have pharmaceutical, metabolic, or industrial significance.

### **Imines**

Imines are compounds containing a carbon-nitrogen double bond and occur in chemical synthesis, metabolism, and drug chemistry.

### **Imino Acid**

imino acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Imipenem**

Imipenem is a broad-spectrum carbapenem antibiotic, usually given with cilastatin, that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis; seizures, allergy, gastrointestinal effects, and selection of resistance are important considerations.

### **Imipramine**

Imipramine is a tricyclic antidepressant that blocks norepinephrine and serotonin reuptake; it treats depression and some bladder symptoms but can cause anticholinergic effects, orthostatic hypotension, ar-

rhythmia, and overdose cardiotoxicity.

### **Imiquimod**

Imiquimod is a topical immune-response modifier that activates Toll-like receptor 7 and induces cytokines; it treats selected actinic keratoses, superficial basal-cell carcinomas, and external genital warts, often causing local inflammation.

### **Immature**

Immature means not fully developed or differentiated, such as an immature cell, organ, tissue, or developmental stage.

### **Immobilization**

A chemical substance or compound called immobilization. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Immune Status**

Immune status describes the functional state of a person's immune defenses, including immunocompetence, prior infection or vaccination, immunosuppression, and susceptibility to infection.

### **Immune System**

Complex network of cells, tissues, and organs that defends the body against pathogens; includes innate and adaptive immunity. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Immunoblast Count**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to immunoblast count. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Immunoblotting**

Immunoblotting, or Western blotting, separates proteins by electrophoresis and detects a target with specific antibodies; band pattern and intensity are interpreted with controls and clinical context.

### **Immunochemistry**

A clinical condition or finding involving immuno-



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chemistry. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunocompetence**

Immunocompetence is the capacity of the immune system to recognize antigens and mount an effective, appropriately regulated response; deficiency increases infection risk and may impair vaccine responses.

### **Immunoconjugate**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunoconjugate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunocytochemistry**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunocytochemistry. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunoelectrophoresis**

A biological or biochemical term involving immunoelectrophoresis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Immunofluorescence Technique**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to immunofluorescence technique. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Immunogenetics**

immunogenetics is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Immunoglobulin D**

immunoglobulin d concerns immunoglobulin d, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Immunoglobulin Idiotyp**

immunoglobulin idiotyp concerns immunoglobulin

idiotyp, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Immunoglobulin Isotype**

immunoglobulin isotype concerns immunoglobulin isotype, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

### **Immunologic Adjuvant**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunologic adjuvant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunologic Factor**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunologic factor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunologic Memory**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunologic memory. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunologic Skin Test**

immunologic skin test is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Immunologic Surveillance**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunologic surveillance. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunologic Technique**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunologic technique. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunologic Test**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to immunologic test. Results are interpreted with the

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method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Immunological Synapse**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunological synapse. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunomodulation**

A chemical substance or compound called immunomodulation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Immunoprecipitation**

A chemical substance or compound called immunoprecipitation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Immunoprotein**

immunoprotein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Immunoradiometric Assay**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to immunoradiometric assay. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Immunoregulation**

A chemical substance or compound called immunoregulation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Immunosuppressive**

Agent or therapy that suppresses immune system activity; used to prevent organ transplant rejection and treat autoimmune diseases. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Immunotoxin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving immunotoxin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host re-

sponse.

### **Immunoturbidimetry**

A biological or biochemical term involving immunoturbidimetry. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Imp Dehydrogenase**

IMP dehydrogenase converts inosine monophosphate to xanthosine monophosphate in guanine-nucleotide synthesis and is a target of some immunosuppressive drugs.

### **Imperforate Vagina**

Imperforate vagina is a rare congenital absence or obstruction of the vaginal canal, often associated with genital outflow obstruction, cyclical pelvic pain, haematocolpos, and urinary or reproductive complications.

### **Implant**

A clinical condition or finding involving implant. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Implantable Defibrillator**

A clinical condition or finding involving implantable defibrillator. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Implantation Procedure**

A medical procedure involving implantation procedure. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Importance Weight**

An importance weight is a statistical weight used to adjust observations so a sample better represents a target population or distribution.

### **Impulsive Behavior**

Impulsive behavior is action with limited forethought or inhibition despite possible harm and may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, substance-

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related, or developmental conditions.

### **In Situ Hybridization**

A chemical substance or compound called in situ hybridization. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **In Vitro**

In vitro means performed outside a living organism, such as in a test tube, culture dish, or laboratory system.

### **Inalimarev**

Inalimarev is an investigational antiviral agent studied for activity against selected viral infections.

### **Inamrinone**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called inamrinone. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Inbreed**

A clinical condition or finding involving inbreed. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inclusion Body**

A circumscribed mass of foreign, metabolic, or abnormal material within a cell's cytoplasm or nucleus. Inclusion bodies may contain aggregated or misfolded proteins, viral components, glycogen, lipids, or other substances, and their appearance and location can help identify cellular injury or disease.

### **Inclusion Conjunctivitis**

A chemical substance or compound called inclusion conjunctivitis. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Incomplete Ossification**

A chemical substance or compound called incomplete ossification. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Increased Libido**

Increased libido is heightened sexual desire that may be normal or associated with hormones, medicines, mood elevation, neurologic disease, or substance use.

### **Increased Osteoid**

Increased osteoid is excess unmineralized bone matrix, seen when bone formation outpaces mineralization as in osteomalacia or some metabolic disorders.

### **Incretins**

Incretins are gut hormones, mainly GLP-1 and GIP, released after meals that enhance glucose-dependent insulin secretion; GLP-1 also suppresses glucagon, slows gastric emptying, and reduces appetite.

### **Incyclinide**

Incyclinide is an investigational tetracycline-derived matrix-metalloproteinase inhibitor studied for anti-inflammatory or anticancer effects.

### **Indapamide**

Indapamide is a thiazide-like diuretic used mainly for hypertension; it promotes renal sodium excretion and may cause hyponatraemia, hypokalaemia, dehydration, hyperuricaemia, or photosensitivity.

### **Indel Mutation**

indel mutation is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Indeterminate**

Indeterminate means not definitively classified or interpreted because available findings are insufficient, conflicting, or nonspecific.

### **Indican**

Indican is a compound formed from tryptophan metabolism and excreted in urine; abnormal levels may occur with intestinal bacterial overgrowth or metabolic disease.

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## Indigo Carmine

Indigo carmine is a blue dye used in selected medical procedures to visualize urinary or other fluid flow and in laboratory staining.

## Indinavir

A medicine or chemical compound called indinavir. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

## Indium

Indium is a metal used in industry and medical radioisotopes; exposure effects depend on the compound, dose, and route.

## Indocyanine Green

Indocyanine green is a fluorescent dye injected intravenously to assess liver function, blood flow, and retinal or choroidal circulation.

## Indole

A clinical condition or finding involving indole. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Indole-3-Carbinol

A clinical condition or finding involving indole-3-carbinol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Indolent

A clinical condition or finding involving indolent. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Indoles

A clinical condition or finding involving indoles. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Indomethacin

Indomethacin is a potent NSAID used for inflammatory pain and selected acute conditions such as gout; gastrointestinal ulceration or bleeding, renal injury, cardiovascular events, and headache are important

adverse effects.

## Indoximod

Indoximod is an investigational immunotherapy that modulates tryptophan metabolism and has been studied in combination cancer treatment.

## Induced Abortion

A chemical substance or compound called induced abortion. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

## Induced Hyperthermia

Induced hyperthermia is deliberate elevation of body or tissue temperature for a therapeutic purpose, with careful monitoring to prevent heat injury.

## Induced Labor

A clinical condition or finding involving induced labor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Indwelling Catheter

A clinical condition or finding involving indwelling catheter. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Infant

An infant is a child in the first year of life, a period of rapid growth and changing feeding, immune, neurologic, and developmental needs.

## Infant Formula

Infant formula is manufactured nutrition designed to provide adequate nutrients when breast milk is unavailable, insufficient, or not chosen; preparation and storage must be safe.

## Infant Gynecomastia

Infant gynecomastia is temporary breast enlargement in a newborn or young infant caused by maternal or neonatal hormones and usually resolves spontaneously.

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### **Infant Incubators**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant incubators. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Leukemia**

A neoplasm involving infant leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Infant Nutrition**

A chemical substance or compound called infant nutrition. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Infant Reflex**

An infant reflex is an automatic response present during early development, such as rooting, sucking, grasping, or startle, whose timing and symmetry help assess neurologic function.

### **Infantile Fibrosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving infantile fibrosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Infantile Spasm**

Infantile spasms are brief epileptic seizures in infancy, often in clusters with flexion or extension movements, and require urgent diagnosis and treatment to protect development.

### **Infectious Arteritis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving infectious arteritis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Infectious Conjunctivitis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving infectious conjunctivitis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Infectious Encephalomyelitis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving infectious encephalomyelitis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Infectious Enterocolitis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving infectious enterocolitis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Infectious Mediastinitis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving infectious mediastinitis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Infective Cervicitis**

Infective cervicitis is inflammation of the cervix caused by organisms such as chlamydia, gonorrhea, trichomonas, or herpes, producing discharge, bleeding, or pelvic discomfort.

### **Infective Cystitis**

Infective cystitis is bacterial or other microbial inflammation of the bladder, causing urinary frequency, urgency, burning, and sometimes blood or fever.

### **Infective Phlebitis**

Infective phlebitis is infection and inflammation of a vein, often around an intravenous catheter, causing pain, redness, swelling, and possible bloodstream infection.

### **Infective Vaginitis**

Infective vaginitis is infection or inflammation of the vagina caused by yeast, bacteria, parasites, or viruses and may cause discharge, itching, odor, or pain.

### **Inferior Colliculus**

The inferior colliculus is a midbrain auditory relay that integrates sound information and helps orient

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reflexively to auditory stimuli.

### **Infiltration**

A chemical substance or compound called infiltration. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Inflammatory Response**

A clinical condition or finding involving inflammatory response. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infliximab**

A medicine or chemical compound called infliximab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Influenza A Virus**

influenza a virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Influenzavirus A**

influenzavirus A is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Influenzavirus B**

influenzavirus b is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Informatics**

Informatics applies information science, data, computing, and human factors to organize and improve healthcare, biology, research, or another field.

### **Informative**

Informative means providing useful information or evidence that improves understanding, decision-

making, diagnosis, or evaluation.

### **Infrared Rays**

Infrared rays are electromagnetic radiation with wavelengths longer than visible red light; excessive exposure can heat tissue and cause burns.

### **Infrared Spectrometry**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to infrared spectrometry. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Infrarenal Aorta**

The infrarenal aorta is the portion of the abdominal aorta below the renal arteries and above its division into the iliac arteries.

### **Infratentorial Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving infratentorial neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Infrequent**

Infrequent means occurring less often than usual or expected, such as infrequent bowel movements, symptoms, or events.

### **Ingredient**

An ingredient is a substance included in a medicine, food, cosmetic, or other preparation, whether active or inactive.

### **Ingrown Nail**

An ingrown nail occurs when the nail edge grows into surrounding skin, causing pain, redness, swelling, and sometimes infection or granulation tissue.

### **Inguinal Orchiectomy**

inguinal orchiectomy is used in relation to inguinal orchiectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Inhalation**

A chemical substance or compound called inhalation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its



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composition and clinical context.

### **Inhibin**

A clinical condition or finding involving inhibin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inhibitory Synapse**

A clinical condition or finding involving inhibitory synapse. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iniparib**

A clinical condition or finding involving iniparib. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Initial Insomnia**

Initial insomnia is difficulty falling asleep at the beginning of the sleep period, often related to stress, habits, medicines, mood, or another sleep disorder.

### **Injury Site**

A clinical condition or finding involving injury site. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inorganic Chemical**

inorganic chemical is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

### **Inosine**

A clinical condition or finding involving inosine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inosine Monophosphate**

A clinical condition or finding involving inosine monophosphate. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inosine Pranobex**

A clinical condition or finding involving inosine pranobex. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inositol**

A clinical condition or finding involving inositol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inositol Phosphates**

A clinical condition or finding involving inositol phosphates. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inpatient**

An inpatient is a person admitted to a healthcare facility for monitoring, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, or care requiring an overnight or formal stay.

### **Inquilineus**

A biomedical term referring to inquilineus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Inquilineus Limosus**

A biomedical term referring to inquilineus limosus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Insect Virus**

insect virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Insecta**

insecta is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Insemination**

A chemical substance or compound called insemina-

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tion. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Inspiratory Capacity**

Inspiratory capacity is the maximum volume inhaled after a normal exhalation and equals tidal volume plus inspiratory reserve volume.

### **Inspiratory Time**

Inspiratory time is the duration of inhalation during a breath or mechanical-ventilation cycle.

### **Insula**

The insula is a cerebral cortical region involved in sensation, taste, emotion, interoception, pain, and integration of internal and external information.

### **Insulin Antagonist**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin antagonist. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin Coma**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin coma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin Detemir**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin detemir. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin Isophane**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin isophane. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin Lispro**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin lispro. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin Receptor**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulin receptor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and

management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulinase**

A clinical condition or finding involving insulinase. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Integrase**

Integrase is an enzyme that inserts viral DNA into a host genome, a process targeted by integrase inhibitors used in HIV treatment.

### **Integrin**

A clinical condition or finding involving integrin. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Integrin Binding**

A clinical condition or finding involving integrin binding. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intein**

An intein is a protein segment that excises itself from a precursor protein while joining the surrounding extein sequences.

### **Intelligence**

Intelligence is the capacity to learn, reason, solve problems, understand information, and adapt; tests measure selected abilities rather than a person's entire worth or potential.

### **Intelligence Test**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intelligence test. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intensive Care**

A patient-care topic concerning intensive care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Intercalated Disc**

An intercalated disc is a specialized junction con-

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necting cardiac muscle cells and transmitting electrical and mechanical force through the heart.

### **Intercalating Agent**

An intercalating agent inserts between DNA base pairs and can disrupt replication or transcription; some are laboratory reagents or anticancer drugs.

### **Intercostal Muscles**

intercostal muscles refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Interferometry**

A medical term referring to interferometry. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Interferon**

Interferons are cytokines that induce antiviral defenses, alter immune-cell activity, and regulate cell growth; type I, II, and III interferons have different receptors and clinical uses.

### **Interferon Inducer**

A clinical condition or finding involving interferon inducer. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interferon-Alpha**

A clinical condition or finding involving interferon-alpha. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interferon-Beta**

A clinical condition or finding involving interferon-beta. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interleukin 1**

A clinical condition or finding involving interleukin 1. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interleukin 13**

A clinical condition or finding involving interleukin 13. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interleukin 2**

Interleukin-2 is a T-cell growth factor that promotes proliferation and survival of activated T cells and natural-killer cells; high-dose therapy can cause capillary-leak syndrome and systemic toxicity.

### **Interleukin 7**

A clinical condition or finding involving interleukin 7. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interlocutory**

Interlocutory means provisional or occurring during an ongoing process, such as an interim clinical, legal, or research decision.

### **Intermediate**

Intermediate means between two stages, positions, or levels, such as an intermediate metabolite, cell, or developmental phase.

### **Intermediate Filament**

An intermediate filament is a strong cytoskeletal fiber that supports cell shape, mechanical stability, and tissue integrity.

### **Intermittent Fever**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving intermittent fever; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Internal**

Internal means located within the body, an organ, a structure, or a system rather than on its outer surface.

### **Internal Fixator**

An internal fixator is a surgically implanted plate, screw, rod, nail, or frame used to stabilize a fracture

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or correct skeletal alignment.

### **International Unit**

A chemical substance or compound called international unit. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Interneuron**

An interneuron connects neurons within the central nervous system and helps integrate, inhibit, or coordinate neural signals.

### **Internist**

An internist is a physician specializing in adult internal medicine, including diagnosis and management of complex medical conditions.

### **Interphase**

Interphase is the portion of the cell cycle between divisions, including growth, DNA replication, and preparation for mitosis or meiosis.

### **Interphase Cell**

interphase cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Interstitial Fluid**

Interstitial fluid is the fluid surrounding tissue cells, formed from blood plasma and returned to circulation through lymphatic vessels.

### **Interval**

An interval is the time, distance, or range between two points or events, such as a dosing or follow-up interval.

### **Interventional Procedure**

A medical procedure involving interventional procedure. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Intestinal Absorption**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to in-

testinal absorption. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestinal Cancer**

A neoplasm involving intestinal cancer. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Intestinal Duplication**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestinal duplication. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestinal Fistula**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestinal fistula. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestinal Mucosa**

intestinal mucosa is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Intestinal Polyp**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestinal polyp. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestinal Polyposis**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestinal polyposis. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestinal Villi**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestinal villi. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intestine Disorder**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestine disorder. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

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### **Intestine Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving intestine neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Intestine Obstruction**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestine obstruction. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intimal Dissection**

A chemical substance or compound called intimal dissection. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Intoplicine**

Intoplicine is an investigational topoisomerase inhibitor studied for anticancer effects by disrupting DNA structure and replication.

### **Intraabdominal Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving intraabdominal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intraabdominal Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving intraabdominal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Intra-Arterial**

Intra-arterial means within an artery, including a catheter, injection, infusion, or measurement performed directly in an arterial vessel.

### **Intraarticular**

Intraarticular means within a joint, such as an injection, fracture, loose body, or inflammatory process inside the joint space.

### **Intrabronchial**

Intrabronchial means within a bronchus, one of the air passages branching from the trachea into the lungs.

### **Intracartilaginous**

Intracartilaginous means located within cartilage, such as a lesion, injection, or developmental structure.

### **Intracavitary**

Intracavitary means within a body cavity, such as a treatment, device, fluid, or lesion located in the thorax, abdomen, uterus, or another cavity.

### **Intracavity Radiotherapy**

intracavity radiotherapy is used in relation to intracavity radiotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Intracellular Membrane**

intracellular membrane refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Intracellular Transport**

intracellular transport refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Intracerebral**

Intracerebral means within the brain tissue, as in an intracerebral hemorrhage, injection, electrode, or lesion.

### **Intracisternal**

Intracisternal means within a cistern, especially a cerebrospinal-fluid space at the base of the brain.

### **Intracoronaral**

Intracoronaral means within the crown of a tooth or within a coronary structure, with the exact meaning determined by context.

### **Intracoronary**

Intracoronary means within a coronary artery or the coronary circulation, such as a catheter, stent, imaging study, or medicine delivery.

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### **Intraduodenal**

Intraduodenal means within the duodenum, the first part of the small intestine beyond the stomach.

### **Intraepidermal**

Intraepidermal means within the epidermis, the outermost layer of skin.

### **Intraesophageal**

Intraesophageal means within the esophagus, such as a probe, pressure sensor, lesion, or medication delivery.

### **Intralesional**

A chemical substance or compound called intralesional. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Intralymphatic**

Intralymphatic means within a lymphatic vessel or channel, such as a medicine, tumor spread, infection, or imaging contrast.

### **Intramedullary**

Intramedullary means within the medulla of an organ or the central canal of a bone, especially an implant placed inside a long bone.

### **Intramural Plaque**

An intramural plaque is an atherosclerotic deposit within an artery wall that can narrow the lumen or destabilize and cause thrombosis.

### **Intramuscular Injection**

A medical procedure involving intramuscular injection. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Intramuscular Myxoma**

An intramuscular myxoma is a rare benign tumor of gelatinous myxoid tissue located within skeletal muscle.

### **Intraocular Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving

intraocular infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Intraocular Lymphoma**

A neoplasm involving intraocular lymphoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Intrapartum Fever**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving intrapartum fever; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Intrapartum Stillbirth**

Intrapartum stillbirth is fetal death occurring during labor after a live fetus was documented before labor, requiring obstetric investigation and support.

### **Intrapericardial**

A biomedical term referring to intrapericardial; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Intraperitoneal**

Intraperitoneal means within the peritoneal cavity or administered into it, including selected medicines, dialysis fluid, or procedures.

### **Intraperitonealroute**

The intraperitoneal route delivers a medicine or fluid into the peritoneal cavity, commonly for peritoneal dialysis or selected treatments.

### **Intraprostatic**

Intraprostatic means within the prostate gland, such as a lesion, injection, infection, or procedure.

### **Intrapulmonary**

A biomedical term referring to intrapulmonary; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.



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### **Intrasynovial**

Intrasynovial means within the synovial lining or fluid-filled space of a joint or tendon sheath.

### **Intratendinous**

Intratendinous means within a tendon, such as a tear, deposit, injection, or degenerative change.

### **Intratesticular**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intratesticular. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intrathoracic**

Intrathoracic means within the chest cavity, including the lungs, heart, mediastinum, vessels, and thoracic lymph nodes.

### **Intratracheal**

Intratracheal means within the trachea, such as a tube, medicine, foreign body, lesion, or route of administration.

### **Intratympanic**

Intratympanic means delivered through the eardrum into the middle ear, often for selected inner-ear disorders or local treatment.

### **Intrauterine**

Intrauterine means within the uterus, including a pregnancy, device, medicine, lesion, or procedure.

### **Intravascular**

Intravascular means within a blood vessel, including a catheter, clot, injection, or process occurring in the circulation.

### **Intravenous Catheters**

A clinical condition or finding involving intravenous catheters. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intravital Microscopy**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intravital microscopy. Results are interpreted with the

method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intrusive Thought**

A clinical condition or finding involving intrusive thought. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inulin**

Inulin is a plant fructan used as a dietary fiber and in tests of glomerular filtration because it is freely filtered and minimally handled by the kidney.

### **Invasive Procedure**

A medical procedure involving invasive procedure. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Invertebrata**

Invertebrata is a broad nonformal grouping of animals without a vertebral column, including worms, mollusks, arthropods, and many other groups.

### **Invertebrate Hormones**

A biological or biochemical term involving invertebrate hormones. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Inverted Papilloma**

A clinical condition or finding involving inverted papilloma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Investigational**

A chemical substance or compound called investigational. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Involuntary Movement**

A clinical condition or finding involving involuntary movement. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iodamoeba Butschlii**

iodamoeba butschlii is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species,

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life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Iodide**

A clinical condition or finding involving iodide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iodipamide**

A clinical condition or finding involving iodipamide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iodoacetamide**

A clinical condition or finding involving iodoacetamide. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iohexol**

A clinical condition or finding involving iohexol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ion**

A chemical substance or compound called ion. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ion Transport**

A chemical substance or compound called ion transport. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ionic Strength**

A chemical substance or compound called ionic strength. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ionization**

A chemical substance or compound called ionization. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ionomycin**

A medicine or chemical compound called ionomycin.

Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Ionophore**

A chemical substance or compound called ionophore. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Iopamidol**

A clinical condition or finding involving iopamidol. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iothalamate Clearance**

Iothalamate clearance estimates glomerular filtration by measuring how quickly injected iothalamate is cleared from blood or urine.

### **Iothalamate Meglumine**

Iothalamate meglumine is an iodinated contrast agent formerly used in radiographic imaging and associated with dose- and kidney-related risks.

### **Iothalamic Acid**

A chemical substance or compound called iothalamic acid. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ioxaglic Acid**

A chemical substance or compound called ioxaglic acid. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ipilimumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called ipilimumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Ipratropium**

Ipratropium is an inhaled short-acting muscarinic antagonist that reduces vagally mediated bronchoconstriction and nasal secretion; it is used in COPD and acute asthma with bronchodilators.

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### **Iratumumab**

A medicine or chemical compound called iratumumab. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Irbesartan**

Irbesartan is an angiotensin-II receptor blocker used for hypertension and diabetic kidney disease; it can cause hyperkalaemia, hypotension, and renal-function changes and is contraindicated in pregnancy.

### **Iridium**

Iridium is a dense metal whose radioactive isotopes, especially iridium-192, are used in industrial testing and some medical brachytherapy.

### **Irinotecan**

A clinical condition or finding involving irinotecan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Irinotecan Hydrochloride**

A clinical condition or finding involving irinotecan hydrochloride. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iris Cyst**

An iris cyst is a fluid-filled lesion on or within the iris, usually benign but sometimes affecting vision, pressure, or the appearance of the eye.

### **Iris Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving iris disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iris Melanoma**

Iris melanoma is a malignant tumor of pigment cells in the iris and may appear as a growing pigmented lesion, pupil distortion, or glaucoma.

### **Iris Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving iris neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Irofulven**

Irofulven is an investigational anticancer compound derived from illudin that damages DNA and has been studied in solid tumors.

### **Iron Overload**

A clinical condition or finding involving iron overload. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Overload Iron (Iron Overload)

### **Irregular Menstruation**

A chemical substance or compound called irregular menstruation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Irregular Respiration**

A chemical substance or compound called irregular respiration. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Irrigation Solution**

A chemical substance or compound called irrigation solution. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Irritable Mood**

A clinical condition or finding involving irritable mood. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Isazophos**

Isazophos is an organophosphate pesticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Ischemic Preconditioning**

A chemical substance or compound called ischemic preconditioning. Its properties, uses, and risks de-

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pend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Ishak Score**

ishak score is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### **Islet Cell**

islet cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Isoantibodies**

A biological or biochemical term involving isoantibodies. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Isoantigen**

A biological or biochemical term involving isoantigen. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Isocarboxazid**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isocarboxazid. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isochromosomes**

A biological or biochemical term involving isochromosomes. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Isocyanate**

A medical term referring to isocyanate. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Isoelectric Point**

A medical term referring to isoelectric point. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Isoetharine**

A medical term referring to isoetharine. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Isofenphos**

A medical term referring to isofenphos. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Isoflavone**

A medical term referring to isoflavone. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Isoflurane**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoflurane. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isoflurophate**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoflurophate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isogeneic Graft**

A biological or biochemical term involving isogeneic graft. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Isolate Compound**

A chemical substance or compound called isolate compound. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Isoleucine**

A biological or biochemical term involving isoleucine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Isomerase**

A chemical substance or compound called isomerase. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

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### Isoniazid

Isoniazid is a first-line antituberculous drug that inhibits mycolic-acid synthesis in *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*; hepatotoxicity and peripheral neuropathy are important risks, and pyridoxine is often given.

### Isoprenylation

A chemical substance or compound called isoprenylation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### Isoprocarb

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoprocarb. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Isopropyl Alcohol

A chemical substance or compound called isopropyl alcohol. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### Isoprostane

A medical term referring to isoprostane. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### Isoproterenol

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoproterenol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Isoquinolines

A medical term referring to isoquinolines. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### Isosorbide

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isosorbide. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Isospora

isospora is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its

medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### Isospora Belli

isospora belli is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### Iso-Sulfan Blue

A medical term referring to iso-sulfan blue. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### Isothiocyanate

A medical term referring to isothiocyanate. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### Isothiocyanates

A medical term referring to isothiocyanates. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### Isotonic Exercise

A clinical condition or finding involving isotonic exercise. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Isotonic Solution

A chemical substance or compound called isotonic solution. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### Isoxsuprine

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoxsuprine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Isozyme

A biological or biochemical term involving isozyme. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

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### Ispaghula Husk

Ispaghula husk, or psyllium, is a soluble fiber that absorbs water and helps regulate stool consistency; adequate fluid is important when using it.

### Ispinesib

Ispinesib is an investigational kinesin-spindle protein inhibitor studied for anticancer effects by disrupting chromosome separation during cell division.

### Isradipine

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isradipine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Itraconazole

Itraconazole is a triazole antifungal that inhibits fungal ergosterol synthesis and treats several superficial and systemic mycoses; absorption, extensive drug interactions, liver injury, and negative inotropic effects require attention.

### Ivabradine

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ivabradine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Ivermectin

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ivermectin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Ixabepilone

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ixabepilone. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### IBS

Alternate index label; see *Irritable bowel syndrome*.

### IDC

Alternate index label; see *Invasive ductal carcinoma (IDC)*.

### Idiopathic Myelofibrosis

Alternate index label; see *Myelofibrosis*.

### Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura

Alternate index label; see *Immune thrombocytopenia (ITP)*.

### Idiopathic Toe Walking

Alternate index label; see *Toe walking in children*.

### IIH

Alternate index label; see *Pseudotumor cerebri (idiopathic intracranial hypertension)*.

### Incontinence, Bowel

Alternate index label; see *Fecal incontinence*.

### Incontinence, Fecal

Alternate index label; see *Fecal incontinence*.

### Incontinence, Urinary

Alternate index label; see *Urinary incontinence*.

### Infantile Hemangioma

Alternate index label; see *Hemangioma*.

### Infectious Hepatitis

Alternate index label; see *Viral hepatitis*.

### Infertility, Female

Alternate index label; see *Female infertility*.

### Infertility, Male

Alternate index label; see *Male infertility*.

### Infiltrating Ductal Carcinoma

Alternate index label; see *Invasive ductal carcinoma (IDC)*.

### Inflamed Gallbladder

Alternate index label; see *Cholecystitis*.

### Inflamed Pancreas

Alternate index label; see *Pancreatitis*.



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### **Inflamed Pericardium**

Alternate index label; see *Pericarditis*.

### **Influenza, Avian**

Alternate index label; see *Bird flu (avian influenza)*.

### **Influenza, H1N1**

Alternate index label; see *H1N1 flu (swine flu)*.

### **Influenza, Swine Flu**

Alternate index label; see *H1N1 flu (swine flu)*.

### **Insulin Resistance Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Metabolic syndrome*.

### **Interdigital Neuroma**

Alternate index label; see *Morton neuroma*.

### **Intestinal Lipodystrophy**

Alternate index label; see *Whipple's disease*.

### **Intraductal Carcinoma**

Alternate index label; see *Ductal carcinoma in situ (DCIS)*.

### **Ischemia, Intestinal**

Alternate index label; see *Intestinal ischemia*.

### **Ischemic Bone Necrosis**

Alternate index label; see *Avascular necrosis (osteonecrosis)*.

### **Ischemic Priapism**

Alternate index label; see *Priapism*.

### **Islet Cell Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Pancreatic neuroendocrine tumors*.

### **ITP**

Alternate index label; see *Immune thrombocytopenia (ITP)*.

### **Ibuprofen Dosing For Children**

A clinical condition or finding involving ibuprofen dosing for children. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ibuprofen Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving ibuprofen overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Idiopathic Hypercalciuria**

Idiopathic hypercalciuria is excessive urinary calcium excretion without an identified systemic cause and can promote kidney stones or, rarely, bone loss.

### **Ileostomy - Caring For Your Stoma**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileostomy - caring for your stoma. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ileostomy - Changing Your Pouch**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileostomy - changing your pouch. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ileostomy - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning ileostomy - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Ileostomy - What To Ask Your Doctor**

A patient-care topic concerning ileostomy - what to ask your doctor. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Ileostomy And Your Child**

A clinical condition or finding involving ileostomy and your child. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## **Ileostomy And Your Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning ileostomy and your diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Iliotibial Band Syndrome - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning iliotibial band syndrome - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Imaging And Radiology**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess imaging and radiology. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## **Imipramine Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving imipramine overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP)**

Immune thrombocytopenic purpura is immune-mediated platelet destruction causing isolated thrombocytopenia with bruising, petechiae, mucosal bleeding, or no symptoms.

## **Immunizations For People With Diabetes**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunizations for people with diabetes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immunoelectrophoresis – Blood**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunoelectrophoresis – blood. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immunoelectrophoresis - Urine**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunoelectrophoresis - urine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immunofixation - Urine**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunofixation - urine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immunofixation Blood Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess immunofixation blood test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## **Immunotherapy For Cancer**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunotherapy for cancer. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Immunotherapy: Questions To Ask Your Doctor**

A clinical condition or finding involving immunotherapy: questions to ask your doctor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Imperforate Anus Repair**

A medical procedure involving imperforate anus repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

## **Implantable Cardioverter Defibrillator - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning implantable cardioverter defibrillator - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **In Vitro Fertilization (IVF)**

In vitro fertilization fertilizes retrieved eggs in a laboratory and transfers resulting embryos to the uterus, forming part of assisted reproductive treatment.

## **Inborn Errors Of Metabolism**

A biological or biochemical term involving inborn errors of metabolism. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

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### **Incontinence - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning incontinence - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Increased Head Circumference**

Increased head circumference means head size above the expected range for age and sex and may reflect familial size, hydrocephalus, swelling, or a genetic condition.

### **Indium-Labelled WBC Scan**

A clinical condition or finding involving indium-labelled wbc scan. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Indomethacin Overdose**

A clinical condition or finding involving indomethacin overdose. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Indoor Fitness Routine**

A clinical condition or finding involving indoor fitness routine. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inducing Labor**

A clinical condition or finding involving inducing labor. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Industrial Bronchitis**

Industrial bronchitis is chronic airway irritation and inflammation related to workplace dusts, fumes, or chemicals, causing cough, phlegm, and breathing limitation.

### **Indwelling Catheter Care**

A patient-care topic concerning indwelling catheter care. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Infant - Newborn Development**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant - newborn development. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Formula - Buying, Preparing, Storing, And Feeding**

A medicine or chemical compound called infant formula - buying, preparing, storing, and feeding. Its uses, effects, interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Infant Formulas**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant formulas. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Of A Substance-Using Mother**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant of a substance-using mother. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Of Diabetic Mother**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant of diabetic mother. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Reflexes**

A clinical condition or finding involving infant reflexes. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Infant Test Procedure Preparation**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess infant test procedure preparation. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Infertility - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning infertility - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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### **Influenza (Flu) Vaccine (Inactivated Or Recombinant) - What You Need To Know**

Inactivated or recombinant influenza vaccines present nonreplicating viral antigens to reduce risk of influenza and its complications; they cannot cause influenza infection.

### **Influenza (Flu) Vaccine (Live, Intranasal) - What You Need To Know**

A clinical condition or finding involving influenza (flu) vaccine (live, intranasal) - what you need to know. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Informed Consent - Adults**

Informed consent requires an adult patient to receive understandable information about a proposed intervention, benefits, risks, alternatives, and refusal before deciding voluntarily.

### **Ingrown Toenail Removal - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving ingrown toenail removal - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Inguinal Hernia Repair**

A medical procedure involving inguinal hernia repair. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Inguinal Hernia Repair - Discharge**

A medical procedure involving inguinal hernia repair - discharge. Indications, risks, preparation, and follow-up depend on the patient and the specific procedure.

### **Injury - Kidney And Ureter**

A clinical condition involving injury - Kidney And Ureter; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Ink Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving ink poison-

ing. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ink Remover Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving ink remover poisoning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insect Bites And Stings**

Insect bites and stings can cause local pain, itching, swelling, allergic reactions, infection, or toxin effects; breathing difficulty or widespread symptoms is an emergency.

### **Insecticide Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving insecticide poisoning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insidious**

A clinical condition or finding involving insidious. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Insulin And Syringes - Storage And Safety**

A patient-care topic concerning insulin and syringes - storage and safety. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Insulin C-Peptide Test**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess insulin c-peptide test. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Insulin Pumps**

Insulin pumps deliver rapid-acting insulin continuously and through programmed meal or correction doses, allowing flexible management of diabetes while requiring monitoring and device safety.

### **Integrative Medicine For Cancer Treatment**

A medicine or chemical compound called integrative medicine for cancer treatment. Its uses, effects,

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interactions, and risks depend on the specific substance and clinical indication.

### **Intercostal Retractions**

A clinical condition or finding involving intercostal retractions. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Interstitial Cystitis - Resources**

A patient-care topic concerning interstitial cystitis - resources. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Interstitial Lung Disease - Adults - Discharge**

A patient-care topic concerning interstitial lung disease - adults - discharge. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

### **Intestinal Leiomyoma**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess intestinal leiomyoma. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Intestinal Obstruction And Ileus**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess intestinal obstruction and ileus. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Intestinal Obstruction Repair**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess intestinal obstruction repair. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Intestinal Or Bowel Obstruction - Discharge**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess intestinal or bowel obstruction - discharge. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Intracardiac Electrophysiology Study**

### **(EPS)**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess intracardiac electrophysiology study (eps). Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

### **Intracranial Pressure Monitoring**

A clinical condition or finding involving intracranial pressure monitoring. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intrauterine Devices (IUD)**

A clinical condition or finding involving intrauterine devices (iud). Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intravenous**

A clinical condition or finding involving intravenous. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intraventricular Hemorrhage Of The Newborn**

Intraventricular hemorrhage in a newborn is bleeding into the brain's ventricular system, most often in premature infants, and can cause hydrocephalus or neurologic injury.

### **Intussusception – Children**

Intussusception occurs when one segment of intestine telescopes into another, causing intermittent pain, vomiting, obstruction, and possible bowel ischemia in children.

### **Invasive**

A clinical condition or finding involving invasive. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Iodine In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning iodine in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

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## **Iodine Poisoning**

Iodine poisoning follows excessive iodine exposure and can irritate the gastrointestinal tract, disrupt thyroid function, and cause systemic toxicity depending on dose and formulation.

## **Ions**

A chemical substance or compound called ions. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

## **IQ Testing**

A diagnostic test or examination used to assess iq testing. Results are interpreted with the clinical findings, method, and reference range.

## **Iron In Diet**

A patient-care topic concerning iron in diet. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Iron Overdose**

Iron overdose can cause gastrointestinal injury, metabolic acidosis, shock, liver failure, and multiorgan toxicity, particularly after a large ingestion by a child.

## **Irradiated Foods**

Irradiated foods are exposed to controlled ionizing radiation to reduce pathogens, insects, or spoilage; the process does not make food radioactive.

## **Irritable Bowel Syndrome - Aftercare**

A patient-care topic concerning irritable bowel syndrome - aftercare. It addresses the relevant purpose, risks, management, and follow-up.

## **Ischemic Ulcers - Self-Care**

Ischemic ulcers are wounds caused by inadequate arterial blood flow; care emphasizes protecting tissue, controlling vascular risk, and obtaining assessment for revascularization when appropriate.

## **Isopropanol Alcohol Poisoning**

A clinical condition or finding involving isopropanol

alcohol poisoning. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **IV Treatment At Home**

A clinical condition or finding involving iv treatment at home. Its defining features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **IBD (Inflammatory Bowel Disease: Intestinal Problems)**

Alternate index label for Inflammatory Bowel Disease: Intestinal Problems.

## **IBD Diet (Inflammatory Bowel Disease (IBD) Diet Plan)**

Alternate index label for Inflammatory Bowel Disease (IBD) Diet Plan.

## **IBD Vs. IBS (IBS Vs IBD Differences And Similarities)**

Alternate index label for IBS vs IBD Differences and Similarities.

## **IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS))**

Alternate index label for Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS).

## **IBS-D Irritable Bowel Syndrome With Diarrhea**

IBS with diarrhea causes recurrent abdominal pain associated with loose stools without structural disease explaining the symptoms. Management may include diet changes, soluble fiber, gut-directed medicines, behavioral therapy, and evaluation for alarm features or alternative diagnoses.

### **Synonyms:**

Diarrhea IBS (IBS-D Irritable Bowel Syndrome With Diarrhea)

## **IC (Interstitial Cystitis)**

Alternate index label for Interstitial Cystitis.

## **Idiopathic Facial Paralysis (Facial Nerve**



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### **Problems)**

Alternate index label for Facial Nerve Problems.

### **Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis (IPF)**

Alternate index label for IPF.

### **Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP)**

Alternate index label for ITP.

### **Ileitis (Crohn's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Crohn's Disease.

### **Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura (Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP))**

Alternate index label for Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP).

### **Impetigo Contagious (Is Impetigo Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Impetigo Contagious.

### **Implants Endometrial (Endometriosis)**

Alternate index label for Endometriosis.

### **Impotence (Erectile Dysfunction (ED, Impotence))**

Alternate index label for Erectile Dysfunction (ED, Impotence).

### **Indirect Vs. Direct Hernia (Direct Vs Indirect Hernia)**

Alternate index label for Direct vs Indirect Hernia.

### **Infants Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

### **Infection Chikungunya (Chikungunya Virus Infection)**

Alternate index label for Chikungunya Virus Infection.

### **Infection Cryptococcus (Cryptococcosis)**

Alternate index label for Cryptococcosis.

### **Infection Cyclospora (Cyclospora Infection (Cyclosporiasis))**

Alternate index label for Cyclospora Infection (Cyclosporiasis).

### **Infection Enterovirus (Enterovirus (Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection))**

Alternate index label for Enterovirus (Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection).

### **Infection HPV (HPV Infection Human Papillomavirus)**

Alternate index label for HPV Infection Human Papillomavirus.

### **Infection Human Papillomavirus (HPV Infection Human Papillomavirus)**

Alternate index label for HPV Infection Human Papillomavirus.

### **Infection Listeria (Listeria)**

Alternate index label for Listeria.

### **Infection Non-Polio Enterovirus (Enterovirus (Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection))**

Alternate index label for Enterovirus (Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection).

### **Infection Pinworms (Pinworm Infection)**

Alternate index label for Pinworm Infection.

### **Infection Sinus Contagious (Is A Sinus Infection Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Sinus Infection Contagious.

### **Infection Testicle (Testicular Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Testicular Disorders.

### **Inflammation Of The Heart Valve**

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### **(Endocarditis)**

Alternate index label for Endocarditis.

### **Inflammation Sclera (Scleritis)**

Alternate index label for Scleritis.

### **Inflammation Vaginal (Vaginitis Overview)**

Alternate index label for Vaginitis Overview.

### **Inflammatory Bowel Disease (IBD) Diet Plan**

Alternate index label for IBD) Diet Pla.

### **Inflammatory Bowel Disease: Intestinal Problems**

Inflammatory bowel disease, including Crohn disease and ulcerative colitis, causes chronic immune-mediated intestinal inflammation with diarrhea, pain, bleeding, weight loss, and extraintestinal effects. Treatment aims for sustained remission and prevention of structural and nutritional complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

IBD (Inflammatory Bowel Disease: Intestinal Problems)

### **Inner Ear Infection**

Inner-ear inflammation can affect hearing and balance, producing vertigo, nausea, tinnitus, or hearing loss. Causes include viral infection, bacterial disease, autoimmune inflammation, or other disorders; sudden hearing loss, severe imbalance, or neurologic signs requires urgent assessment.

### **Internal Bleeding**

Internal bleeding is blood loss into a body cavity, tissue, or organ rather than through an obvious external wound. Trauma, ulcers, aneurysm, pregnancy complications, medicines, and tumors can cause it; faintness, shock, abdominal swelling, black stool, or vomiting blood is an emergency.

### **Interstitial Lung Disease (Interstitial**

### **Pneumonia)**

Alternate index label for Interstitial Pneumonia.

### **Intestinal Gas (Belching, Bloating, Flatulence)**

Alternate index label for Belching, Bloating, Flatulence.

### **Intestinal Gas (Intestinal Gas (Belching, Bloating, Flatulence))**

Alternate index label for Intestinal Gas (Belching, Bloating, Flatulence).

### **Intolerance, Gluten (Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance))**

Alternate index label for Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance).

### **Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

### **IPMN Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

### **IR (Insulin Resistance)**

Alternate index label for Insulin Resistance.

### **Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS)**

Alternate index label for IBS.

### **Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention**

Alternate index label for IBS) Triggers, Preventio.

### **Ischemic Chest Pain (Angina Symptoms)**

Alternate index label for Angina Symptoms.

### **ITBS (Iliotibial Band Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Iliotibial Band Syndrome.

### **Itch**

Itch, or pruritus, is an unpleasant skin sensation that provokes scratching and may arise from dermatitis,

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allergy, infection, medicines, kidney or liver disease, blood disorders, nerve disease, or systemic illness. Persistent generalized itch requires evaluation.

**Synonyms:**

Pruritus (Itch)

**Itching, Anal**

Itching around the anus, commonly caused by irritant dermatitis, hemorrhoids, pinworms, infection, inflammatory skin disease, or hygiene-related irritation. Persistent, severe, bleeding, painful, or unexplained symptoms require examination.

**Itching Anal (Anal Itching)**

Alternate index label for Anal Itching.

**ITP (Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP))**

Alternate index label for Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (ITP).

**Iatr-**

A combining form meaning medical treatment or physician, as in iatrogenic and iatrosurgery.

**Iatrics**

A suffix or word element referring to medical treatment or a medical specialty, as in geriatrics and pediatrics.

**Iatry**

A suffix meaning medical treatment or a medical specialty, as in psychiatry and podiatry.

**ICU**

Abbreviation for intensive care unit, a hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and specialized support for critically ill patients.

**ID**

A context-dependent abbreviation that may mean infectious disease, infectious diseases specialist, intellectual disability, or identification; the surrounding clinical text determines the meaning.

**IFA**

Abbreviation for indirect fluorescent antibody, a laboratory method that detects antibodies or antigens using fluorescent labels, commonly in serologic testing.

**Ig**

Abbreviation for immunoglobulin, an antibody protein produced by B cells and plasma cells; major classes include IgG, IgA, IgM, IgE, and IgD.

**IHS**

Abbreviation for the Indian Health Service, a US federal agency providing health services to American Indians and Alaska Native people and communities.

**Ileitis, Crohn**

Crohn disease involving the ileum, the final part of the small intestine, causing chronic or relapsing inflammation that may produce abdominal pain, diarrhea, weight loss, strictures, or fistulas.

**Ileocolitis, Crohn**

Crohn disease affecting both the ileum and colon, causing patchy chronic inflammation that may lead to abdominal pain, diarrhea, weight loss, strictures, fistulas, or perianal disease.

**Iliac**

Relating to the ilium or the iliac region, including the iliac bones and iliac blood vessels.

**IM (Intramuscular)**

Abbreviation for intramuscular, describing administration or placement into skeletal muscle, such as an intramuscular injection.

**Immune**

Having an immune response that recognizes and helps protect against a particular antigen, infection, or toxin; immunity may be innate or acquired.

**Immunocompetent**

Having an immune system capable of mounting an appropriate response to common infectious or

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foreign antigens.

### **Immunocompromised**

Having weakened or impaired immune defenses because of disease, medication, cancer treatment, transplantation, or another cause, increasing susceptibility to some infections and complications.

### **Impact**

The forceful contact or collision of one object or body part with another, or the effect a disease, treatment, or event has on health; context determines the meaning.

### **Impulsivity**

A tendency to act quickly without adequate consideration of consequences or difficulty delaying a response; it can occur in ADHD, mania, substance use, and other conditions.

### **In**

In clinical measurements, an abbreviation for inch or inches; the same letters may have other meanings in different contexts.

### **Inbreeding, Coefficient Of**

The probability that the two copies of a gene at a locus in an individual are identical by descent from a common ancestor; it is used in population and medical genetics.

### **Indicate**

To show, suggest, or point to a finding or conclusion; an indication is a clinical reason for using a test, treatment, or procedure.

### **Induration**

Abnormal hardening of tissue, often detected by palpation and caused by inflammation, infection, edema, fibrosis, or a mass.

### **Industrial Health**

The branch of occupational health concerned with preventing and managing illness and injury related to industrial work, workplace exposures, and work-

ing conditions.

### **Infant, Post-Term**

An infant born at or after 42 weeks of gestation, beyond the usual term-pregnancy period; risks depend on placental function, fetal condition, and circumstances of delivery.

### **Infantile Paralysis (Polio)**

Paralytic poliomyelitis caused by poliovirus infection involving motor neurons, which can produce acute flaccid paralysis and respiratory failure; vaccination prevents most cases.

### **Infection, Hospital-Acquired**

An infection acquired during or as a result of health-care that was not present or incubating at the time of admission; it may be caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or other organisms.

### **Infection, Urinary Tract (UTI)**

Infection of part of the urinary system, commonly the bladder or urethra and sometimes the kidneys, usually caused by bacteria and producing symptoms such as burning urination, urgency, or flank pain.

### **Inferolateral**

Located below and toward the side of a reference structure.

### **Informed Consent**

A patient's voluntary agreement to a proposed intervention after receiving understandable information about its purpose, benefits, risks, alternatives, and the option of declining, with decision-making capacity or appropriate authorization.

### **Infuse**

To introduce a fluid, medicine, or other substance gradually into the body, commonly through an intravenous line; it can also mean to soak a substance in a liquid.

### **Inguinal**

Relating to the groin, the region where the lower

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abdomen meets the upper thigh.

### **Injury**

Damage to the body's tissues or function caused by trauma, force, heat, chemicals, radiation, or another harmful exposure.

### **Inotropic**

Affecting the force of cardiac muscle contraction; a positive inotropic drug increases contractility, while a negative inotropic effect decreases it.

### **Insinuate**

To introduce or insert gradually into a space, or to suggest something indirectly; in anatomy, a structure may insinuate between or around other structures.

### **Integron**

A genetic element containing an integrase and an attachment site that can capture and express gene cassettes; integrons commonly contribute to bacterial antimicrobial resistance.

### **Intercurrent Disease**

An illness or complication that develops during the course of another disease or treatment and may affect its management or outcome.

### **Intern**

A physician in the early stage of postgraduate medical training, traditionally the first year after medical school; the exact training structure varies by country.

### **Internal Fixation**

Surgical stabilization of a fracture or unstable bone using implanted hardware such as plates, screws, rods, wires, or pins.

### **Internal Medicine**

The medical specialty focused on prevention, diagnosis, and nonsurgical treatment of diseases in adults, including complex multisystem illness.

### **International Normalized Ratio**

The INR, a standardized calculation from the prothrombin time used to assess blood clotting and guide treatment with vitamin K antagonists such as warfarin.

### **International Unit (IU)**

A unit expressing the biological activity or potency of a substance, such as a vitamin, hormone, enzyme, or medication; its quantity by mass varies by substance.

### **Interstitial**

Relating to the spaces between cells or tissues, such as interstitial fluid or interstitial lung disease.

### **Interstitial Cystitis (IC)**

A chronic bladder pain syndrome with urinary urgency, frequency, or pain without an identifiable infection or other cause sufficient to explain the symptoms.

### **Intervening Sequence**

A nucleotide sequence within a gene transcript that lies between coding sequences; in many genes it is an intron removed during RNA processing.

### **Intervention**

An action intended to prevent, diagnose, treat, or change a health condition or outcome, such as a medicine, procedure, counseling, or public-health measure.

### **Interventional**

Relating to a procedure or active treatment used to diagnose or manage disease, often through minimally invasive access rather than open surgery.

### **Interventional Radiology (IR)**

A specialty using imaging guidance to perform minimally invasive diagnostic and therapeutic procedures, such as biopsies, drainages, embolization, and vascular treatments.

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**Intestinal Parasite**

A protozoan or worm that lives in the gastrointestinal tract and may cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, anemia, malnutrition, or no symptoms.

**Intracellular**

Located or occurring within a cell.

**Intracranial**

Located within the skull or cranial cavity.

**Intractable**

Difficult to control, relieve, or cure despite appropriate treatment, as in intractable pain or seizures.

**Intradermal**

Located within the dermis, the layer of skin beneath the epidermis; an intradermal injection places medication or test material into that layer.

**Intraepithelial**

Located within or occurring among the cells of an epithelial layer.

**Intrahepatic**

Located or occurring within the liver.

**Intramuscular (IM)**

Located within skeletal muscle or administered into skeletal muscle, as with an intramuscular injection.

**Intraocular**

Located within the eye.

**Intraoperative**

Occurring during a surgical operation, including monitoring, findings, complications, or treatment decisions made during the procedure.

**Intraoral**

Located within the mouth or performed through the mouth.

**Intravenous (IV)**

Into or within a vein; intravenous medicines, fluids, or blood products are delivered directly into the bloodstream.

**Intrinsic**

Belonging naturally to a structure or process and arising from within it, rather than being externally imposed.

**Intubate**

To place a tube into a body passage, especially an endotracheal tube through the mouth or nose into the trachea to maintain an airway or support ventilation.

**Invert**

To turn upside down, reverse, or turn inward; in anatomy, inversion can describe movement of the sole of the foot toward the midline.

**Involuntary**

Occurring without conscious control or deliberate choice, such as a reflex, autonomic function, or involuntary muscle movement.

**Involute**

To shrink, return toward a former size, or undergo involution; in anatomy, an involute structure may be tightly coiled or rolled inward.

**IOP (Intraocular Pressure)**

The pressure of fluid within the eye, usually measured to assess risk for or management of glaucoma and other eye disorders.

**IPT**

Abbreviation for interpersonal therapy, a structured psychotherapy that focuses on relationships, grief, role transitions, and interpersonal difficulties.

**IPV**

Abbreviation for inactivated polio vaccine, an injectable vaccine containing killed poliovirus and used to prevent poliomyelitis.



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## **IQ**

Abbreviation for intelligence quotient, a standardized score from cognitive testing; it describes performance on specified tests and is not a complete measure of a person's abilities or worth.

## **Irradiation**

Exposure to or treatment with radiation; irradiation may be used diagnostically or therapeutically, or may cause tissue injury depending on dose and type.

## **Irrigate**

To wash or flush a body part, wound, cavity, or medical device with a fluid to remove debris, contaminants, or secretions.

## **Iso-**

A prefix meaning equal, same, or uniform, as in isotonic and isometric.

## **Isolate**

To separate a person, organism, tissue, or substance from others; infection-control isolation separates people who may transmit a pathogen.

## **Isometropia**

The condition in which both eyes have approximately equal refractive power, so neither eye has substantially more near-sightedness, far-sightedness, or astigmatism than the other.

## **ITC**

Abbreviation for in-the-canal, describing a hearing aid or other device positioned within the ear canal.

## **Itchy Ear**

An itching sensation of the external ear or ear canal, which may result from dermatitis, allergy, infection, dryness, or irritation from objects placed in the ear.

## **Itis**

A suffix meaning inflammation, as in dermatitis, bronchitis, and arthritis.

## **ITN**

Abbreviation for insecticide-treated bednet, a net treated with insecticide to reduce mosquito bites and malaria transmission.

## **IU (International Unit)**

A unit of biological activity or potency for a substance such as a vitamin, hormone, or medicine; the corresponding mass differs by substance.

## **IUD (Intrauterine Contraceptive Device)**

A small device placed in the uterus to prevent pregnancy; copper IUDs release copper, while hormonal IUDs release a progestin, and both are highly effective reversible contraception.

## **IV (Intravenous)**

Abbreviation for intravenous, meaning into or within a vein; IV access can deliver fluids, medicines, blood products, or nutrition directly into the bloodstream.

## **IVC**

Commonly abbreviation for inferior vena cava, the large vein returning blood from the lower body to the heart; it can also mean intravenous cholangiogram, an X-ray study of the biliary system.

## **IgA Nephropathy (Berger Disease)**

A kidney disease caused by deposits of immunoglobulin A in the kidney filters, potentially leading to blood in urine, protein loss, high blood pressure, or kidney failure.

### **Synonyms:**

Berger's Disease

## **Intestinal Gas**

Gas in the digestive tract that may cause belching, bloating, abdominal discomfort, or flatulence.

## **Influenza (Flu)**

A contagious respiratory infection caused by influenza viruses, commonly producing fever, cough, body aches, fatigue, and respiratory symptoms.

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### **Incomplete Miscarriage**

Partial expulsion of products of conception, with some pregnancy tissue remaining in the uterus.

### **Icteric**

A medical term referring to icteric. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idaiovirus**

A medical term referring to idaiovirus. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idea**

A medical term referring to idea. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idea Of Reference**

A medical term referring to idea of reference. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Ideation**

A chemical substance or compound called ideation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Identical Twins**

Identical Twins is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Ideopathic**

A medical term referring to ideopathic. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idiosyncrasy**

A medical term referring to idiosyncrasy. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idiot**

A medical term referring to idiot. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Idiotypic**

Idiotypic is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Ileocaecal**

Ileocaecal is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Imerslund-Gräsbeck Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving imerslund-gräsbeck syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Imidazoles**

A medical term referring to imidazoles. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Immaturity**

A clinical condition or finding involving immaturity. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Immunoassay**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to immunoassay. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Immunological Tolerance**

A biological or biochemical term involving immunological tolerance. Its role depends on the relevant cells, tissues, molecules, or physiological process.

### **Impedance**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to impedance. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

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### **Impulse**

Impulse is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **In-Vivo**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to in-vivo. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Inactivator**

Inactivator is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Inanition**

A chemical substance or compound called inanition. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Inbreeding**

Inbreeding is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Incest**

Incest is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Incisors**

Incisors is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Incoordinatio**

A medical term referring to incoordinatio. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **NIncontinence**

A clinical condition or finding involving nincontinence. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Incoordination**

A chemical substance or compound called incoordination. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Increment**

A medical term referring to increment. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Incubation**

Incubation is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Indometacin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called indometacin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Induction**

A chemical substance or compound called induction. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Industrial Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving industrial disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inertia**

A medical term referring to inertia. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Infra-**

A medical term referring to infra-. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Inhalant**

A medical term referring to inhalant. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the

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context in which it is used.

### **Inherited Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving inherited disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Inhibition**

Inhibition is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Innominate**

Innominate is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Inorganic**

Inorganic is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Inosculation**

A chemical substance or compound called inosculation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Insane**

A medical term referring to insane. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Insanity**

A medical term referring to insanity. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Insect Bites**

A medical term referring to insect bites. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Insecticide**

A chemical substance or compound called insecticide. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Instillation**

Instillation is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Instinct**

A medical term referring to instinct. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Instrument**

A medical term referring to instrument. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Insufficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving insufficiency. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Intention Tremor**

A chemical substance or compound called intention tremor. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Intercellular**

Intercellular is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Intercostal**

Intercostal is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Internal Environment**

A medical term referring to internal environment.

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Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Interosseous**

Interosseous is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Intersexual**

Intersexual is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Intestine, Diseases Of**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to intestine, diseases of. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Intra-**

Intra- is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Intrathecal**

Intrathecal is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Intrauterine Contraceptive Device (IUCD)**

Intrauterine Contraceptive Device (IUCD) is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Inuresis**

A medical term referring to inuresis. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Inutero**

A medical term referring to inutero. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the

context in which it is used.

### **Invert Sugar**

A chemical substance or compound called invert sugar. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Invertase**

A medical term referring to invertase. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Invertebrate**

A medical term referring to invertebrate. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Inveterate**

A medical term referring to inveterate. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **In Vivo**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to in vivo. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Involucrum**

Involucrum is an anatomical structure, tissue relationship, physiologic process, or body function; its location and mechanism explain its clinical significance.

### **Iodoform**

A chemical substance or compound called iodoform. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Iproniazid**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called iproniazid. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Irregular**

A clinical condition or finding involving irregular.

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Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Irritation**

A chemical substance or compound called irritation. Its properties, uses, and risks depend on its composition and clinical context.

### **Isoaminile**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoaminile. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isoenzyme**

Isoenzyme is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Isometheptene**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isometheptene. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isoprenaline**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isoprenaline. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Isopropamide**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called isopropamide. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **IUCD**

A medical term referring to iucd. Its precise meaning and clinical importance depend on the context in which it is used.

### **Ixodes**

Ixodes is an immunologic, genetic, infectious, developmental, or cellular concept used to explain disease mechanisms, diagnosis, or treatment.

### **Impedance Plethysmography**

A noninvasive method that detects changes in limb electrical impedance caused by changes in blood volume. It has been used to assess venous blood flow and suspected deep-vein thrombosis, although duplex ultrasonography is generally preferred for current diagnostic evaluation.

### **INOCA**

Ischemia with non-obstructive coronary arteries: objective myocardial ischemia or ischemic symptoms in a patient whose coronary arteries do not have an obstructive epicardial stenosis. Mechanisms include coronary microvascular dysfunction and vasospastic angina; evaluation should identify the mechanism so treatment can be tailored.

### **Indurated**

Abnormally firm or hardened when palpated, usually because of inflammation, edema, fibrosis, infiltration, or a tumor within the skin or underlying tissue.

### **Intravascular Hemolysis**

Destruction of red blood cells within the bloodstream, releasing hemoglobin into plasma; causes include immune hemolysis, mechanical trauma, infections, toxins, and transfusion reactions.

### **Immunogenicity**

The ability of an antigen, vaccine, or other substance to provoke an immune response, including antibody or cellular responses.

### **Intravenous Immunoglobulin**

A purified preparation of pooled antibodies given through a vein (IVIg) for selected immune deficiencies, autoimmune diseases, inflammatory disorders, and some neurologic conditions.

### **Idiopathic Interstitial Pneumonias**

A group of interstitial lung diseases with no identified cause, characterized by varying degrees of lung inflammation and fibrosis; diagnosis requires clinical, radiologic, and sometimes pathologic assessment.



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## Interstitial Lung Diseases

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial Lung Disease*.

## Interstitium

The supporting tissue between and around the lung air sacs, capillaries, and small airways; inflammation or fibrosis of this tissue can impair lung expansion and gas exchange.

## Intravenous Sedation

Administration of sedative medicines through a vein to reduce anxiety, discomfort, or awareness during a procedure while maintaining appropriate monitoring and readiness to support breathing.

## Intravenous Leiomyomatosis

Extension of benign uterine smooth-muscle tumor into venous channels, sometimes reaching the inferior vena cava or right heart. Imaging is important because extensive disease can cause serious cardiovascular complications.

## Ischemic Fasciitis

A benign fibroblastic and myofibroblastic proliferation associated with pressure-related ischemic injury, usually arising in deep soft tissue over bony prominences in debilitated or immobile patients.

## Integrative Medicine

Patient-centered care that combines evidence-based conventional treatment with appropriate complementary approaches, emphasizing whole-person health, prevention, lifestyle, and shared decision-making.

## Interventional Cardiology

A subspecialty using catheter-based procedures to diagnose and treat coronary, structural, and selected vascular heart conditions, including angioplasty, stenting, and transcatheter valve procedures.

## ICD-O Neoplasm Morphology Classification

A tumor-coding system that records histologic type and biologic behavior using morphology ranges and

behavior codes, rather than assigning a clinical diagnosis or stage. The listed groups include epithelial, squamous, basal-cell, glandular, adnexal, mucoepidermoid, cystic, ductal, lobular, medullary, acinar, and complex epithelial neoplasms. Representative ranges are 8010–8045 for epithelial, 8050–8080 for squamous, 8090–8110 for basal-cell, 8140–8380 for adenocarcinomas, and 8390–8580 for adnexal, mucoepidermoid, cystic, ductal, acinar, and complex epithelial groups. Examples of behavior-coded entities include Squamous Cell Carcinoma, Basal Cell Carcinoma, Adenocarcinoma, Linitis Plastica, VIPoma, Cholangiocarcinoma, Hepatocellular Carcinoma, Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma, and Renal Cell Carcinoma. Examples of malignant behavior codes include M8070/3 for Squamous Cell Carcinoma, M8090/3 for Basal Cell Carcinoma, M8140/3 for Adenocarcinoma, M8160/3 for Cholangiocarcinoma, and M8312/3 for Renal Cell Carcinoma. ICD-O morphology codes support cancer registries, pathology reporting, epidemiology, and research; they should be interpreted alongside the anatomic site, clinical findings, and staging system.



## J

### Jaccoud's Arthropathy

A non-erosive, reducible deformity of the metacarpophalangeal joints caused by chronic periarticular fibrosis and tendon laxity, most commonly associated with systemic lupus erythematosus.

### Jacksonian Epilepsy (Focal Seizures)

A type of focal (partial) seizure originating in the primary motor cortex, characterized by clonic (rhythmic jerking) or tonic (sustained contraction) movements that spread sequentially to adjacent body parts along the motor homunculus (Jacksonian march). Named after John Hughlings Jackson (1835-1911), who first described the phenomenon.

#### Synonyms:

Focal Seizures

### JAK-STAT Pathway

A rapid signaling pathway for cytokines and growth factors (interferons, interleukins, erythropoietin, growth hormone) that lack intrinsic enzymatic activity. Ligand binding to the cytokine receptor causes receptor dimerization and activation of associated Janus kinases (JAK1, JAK2, JAK3, TYK2) by trans-phosphorylation.

### JAK2

Janus kinase 2, an intracellular tyrosine kinase that transmits signals from several cytokine and growth-factor receptors. Activating JAK2 variants occur in some myeloproliferative neoplasms.

### Janeway Lesions

Painless, erythematous or hemorrhagic macules on the palms and soles, caused by septic microemboli in infective endocarditis. They are a minor criterion

in the Duke criteria. Unlike Osler nodes, Janeway lesions are painless and represent microabscesses in the dermis. They are transient and may disappear quickly.

### Janus Kinase Inhibitors

JAK inhibitors (tofacitinib, baricitinib, upadacitinib, filgotinib, abrocitinib) block JAK-STAT signaling downstream of cytokine receptors (IL-6, IFN-gamma, IL-2, IL-7, IL-15, IL-21, GM-CSF, erythropoietin, thrombopoietin). Selectivity: JAK1/JAK3 (tofacitinib), JAK1/JAK2 (baricitinib), JAK1 (upadacitinib, filgotinib, abrocitinib).

### Japanese Encephalitis

A mosquito-borne viral infection of the central nervous system caused by Japanese encephalitis virus. Most infections are asymptomatic, but severe disease can cause fever, altered consciousness, seizures, movement disorders, and lasting neurological disability.

### Japanese Encephalitis Vaccine

A vaccine that protects against Japanese encephalitis, a mosquito-borne viral infection of the central nervous system. Vaccine type, schedule, and eligibility depend on age, destination or exposure risk, and local recommendations.

### Jaundice

Jaundice is yellow discoloration of the skin and eyes caused by elevated bilirubin from increased production, impaired liver processing, or obstructed bile flow. hyperbilirubinemia (serum bilirubin greater than 2-3 mg/dL), resulting from an imbalance between bilirubin production and clearance.

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## Jaundice (Icterus)

Yellow discoloration of the skin, sclerae, or mucous membranes caused by an increased bilirubin concentration in the blood.

### Synonyms:

Icterus

## Jaundice In Newborns

Yellow discoloration of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by elevated bilirubin.

## Jaw Pain

Pain in the jaw, jaw joint, or chewing muscles caused by temporomandibular disorders, dental disease, infection, injury, or less commonly heart or nerve disease. Pain with chest discomfort, sweating, breathlessness, or exertion requires urgent assessment; persistent pain or restricted jaw movement requires dental or medical review.

## Jejunal Atresia

Congenital complete interruption or absence of a segment of the jejunal lumen. It presents in a newborn with intestinal obstruction, commonly causing bilious vomiting, abdominal distension, and failure to pass meconium, and generally requires surgery.

## Jejunostomy

A surgically created opening into the jejunum, often used for placement of a feeding tube when nutrition cannot safely be given through the stomach.

## Jejunum

Middle segment (2.5 m) with prominent circular folds and tall villi for a velvety appearance. Richer blood supply and thicker walls than the ileum. Primary nutrient absorption site for carbohydrates, amino acids, fatty acids, vitamins, minerals. Fewer Peyer's patches. More commonly affected by Crohn's disease.

## Job Syndrome

A primary immunodeficiency, usually caused by pathogenic variants affecting STAT3, characterized by eczema, recurrent staphylococcal skin and lung

infections, and markedly elevated immunoglobulin E. Skeletal, dental, and characteristic facial findings may also occur.

## Jock Itch

A fungal infection of the groin and inner thighs, also called tinea cruris. It causes an itchy, scaly, ring-shaped or spreading rash, often worsened by warmth and moisture. Pain, fever, extensive involvement, or failure to improve with appropriate care requires clinical evaluation.

### Synonyms:

tinea cruris. Tinea Cruris

## Joint

Articulation between two or more bones permitting movement. Structural classification: fibrous (sutures, syndesmoses, gomphoses – immovable/slightly movable), cartilaginous (synchondroses, symphyses – slightly movable), synovial (freely movable – plane, hinge, pivot, condyloid, saddle, ball-and-socket).

## Joint Contracture

Persistent limitation of passive joint movement caused by shortening or fibrosis of muscle, tendon, capsule, ligament, fascia, skin, or other periarticular tissue. It may follow immobilization, neurological disease, trauma, inflammation, burns, or congenital disorders.

## Joint Diseases

A broad category of pathological conditions affecting the structure and function of joints. Classification by etiology: (1) Degenerative: osteoarthritis (most common, non-inflammatory, affects load-bearing joints—knee, hip, spine).

## Joint Effusion

Excess fluid within a joint space. Common sites: knee (most accessible), ankle, wrist, shoulder. Causes: trauma, infection, inflammatory arthritis, crystal arthropathy. Detected by ballottement or bulge sign.

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## Joint Pain

Discomfort arising from articular structures including cartilage, synovium, ligaments, and periarticular soft tissues due to inflammation, degeneration, injury, or infection.

### Joint Pain, Monoarticular

Pain affecting one joint, caused by trauma, infection, crystal arthritis, osteoarthritis, or inflammatory arthritis. Acute monoarticular pain with swelling, warmth, fever, or inability to bear weight requires urgent assessment for septic arthritis.

### Joint Pain, Polyarticular

Pain affecting multiple joints, caused by systemic inflammatory disease, infection, osteoarthritis, crystal disease, medication, or other conditions. The pattern, duration, swelling, and associated symptoms guide evaluation.

## Jaundice In Neonates

Yellowing of a newborn's skin or eyes from elevated bilirubin. It is often physiologic, but jaundice in the first 24 hours, rapidly increasing jaundice, poor feeding, lethargy, fever, pale stools, or dark urine requires urgent evaluation.

## Joint Prosthesis

An artificial joint or implant designed to replace a damaged or diseased biological joint, restoring mobility and relieving chronic pain.

## Joint Replacement

Surgical replacement of damaged joint surfaces with prosthetic components to reduce pain and improve function.

### Joint Replacement (Arthroplasty)

A surgical procedure in which a damaged or arthritic joint surface is removed and replaced with a prosthetic implant, most commonly performed for the hip (total hip arthroplasty) and knee (total knee arthroplasty).

#### Synonyms:

Arthroplasty

## Joint Replacement Rehabilitation

Exercise, education, and functional training after joint replacement to restore safe movement and independence.

## Joint Stiffness

Reduced ease or range of joint movement, often worse after rest. Causes include arthritis, injury, inflammation, prolonged immobility, or muscle and tendon disorders. Sudden swelling, redness, fever, severe pain, or inability to use the joint requires assessment.

## Joint Swelling

Enlargement of a joint caused by excess synovial fluid, blood, inflammation, infection, trauma, or structural disease. It may be accompanied by pain, warmth, stiffness, or restricted movement and can indicate inflammatory or septic arthritis.

## Jugular Vein

One of the major veins draining blood from the head, face, and neck. There are two pairs: internal jugular vein (IJV) and external jugular vein (EJV).

## Juvenile Angiofibroma

Juvenile angiofibroma is a benign but highly vascular tumor arising near the nasal cavity in adolescent boys, causing progressive nasal obstruction and recurrent nosebleeds, predominantly in adolescent boys. It may cause recurrent nosebleeds, nasal obstruction, or facial swelling.

## Juvenile Arthritis

A general term for inflammatory arthritis beginning in childhood. Persistent joint swelling, pain, stiffness, or limited movement may occur, and causes and subtypes vary.

#### Synonyms:

Arthritis Juvenile (Juvenile Arthritis)

## Juvenile Astrocytoma

An astrocytic glioma arising in a child or adolescent. Many are low-grade and may cause seizures, headache, visual symptoms, endocrine disturbance,

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or focal neurological deficits depending on location; diagnosis requires neuroimaging and tumour evaluation.

### **Juvenile Dermatomyositis**

An inflammatory muscle disease of childhood characterized by proximal weakness and distinctive skin findings such as heliotrope rash and Gottron papules. It may also affect blood vessels, muscles, or other organs.

### **Juvenile Hypermobility Syndrome**

Excessive joint movement in a child or adolescent associated with pain, instability, fatigue, or recurrent sprains, without another defined connective-tissue disorder. Assessment considers the pattern of hypermobility, skin and systemic features, and functional impact; management may include physiotherapy and joint protection.

### **Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis**

A group of inflammatory arthritis disorders that begin before age 16 and persist for at least six weeks without another identified cause. Subtypes differ in the number of joints affected, systemic symptoms, associated eye disease, and laboratory findings.

### **Juvenile Osteoporosis**

Reduced bone mass or impaired bone strength occurring during childhood or adolescence, increasing fracture risk. It may be primary or secondary to chronic disease, nutritional deficiency, endocrine disorder, immobility, or medication exposure.

### **Juvenile Rheumatoid Arthritis**

An older term for juvenile idiopathic arthritis, chronic inflammatory arthritis beginning before adulthood.

### **Juvenile Xanthogranuloma**

A benign non-Langerhans-cell histiocytic disorder that most often presents in infancy or early childhood as a yellow-red papule or nodule. Skin lesions are usually self-limited, but ocular or visceral involvement can occur and requires appropriate assessment.

### **Juxta-Articular**

Located next to or close to a joint.

### **Juxtaglomerular Apparatus**

Specialized structure located at the vascular pole of the glomerulus where the distal tubule comes into contact with the afferent arteriole. Composed of macula densa cells in the tubular wall, juxtaglomerular cells in the afferent arteriolar wall that produce renin, and extraglomerular mesangial cells.

### **Juxtavesical**

Located next to or near the urinary bladder.

### **Jaw Fracture**

A break in the upper or lower jawbone.

### **Jackknife Position**

A prone position in which the operating table is flexed at the hips, raising the buttocks and lowering the head and legs.

### **Jaw Tumors And Cysts**

Abnormal growths or fluid-filled sacs that develop in the jawbone or nearby tissues.

#### **Synonyms:**

Odontogenic Tumors And Cysts

### **Jellyfish Stings**

Skin injury caused by contact with jellyfish tentacles, which release venom and may cause pain or systemic symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stings, Jellyfish

### **Jaccoud Arthropathy**

A deforming but usually nonerosive arthropathy, classically associated with previous rheumatic fever or systemic lupus erythematosus, causing reducible ulnar deviation and other hand deformities.

### **Junctional Rhythm**

A cardiac rhythm arising from the atrioventricular junction rather than the sinoatrial node, usually with a narrow QRS complex and a slow or absent



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preceding atrial impulse.

### **Juvenile Myoclonic Epilepsy**

A generalized epilepsy syndrome that typically begins in adolescence and causes myoclonic jerks, often after awakening, with possible generalized tonic-clonic or absence seizures.

### **Juvenile Polyposis Syndrome**

An inherited disorder characterized by multiple hamartomatous polyps in the gastrointestinal tract and an increased risk of colorectal and other gastrointestinal cancers.

### **Jarisch-Herxheimer Reaction**

A short-lived systemic reaction, with fever, chills, headache, muscle aches, and worsening of existing symptoms, that may occur soon after antibiotic treatment of certain bacterial infections, especially spirochaetal infections.

### **Jaw Jerk Reflex**

A stretch reflex of the jaw muscles elicited by tapping the chin while the mouth is slightly open; an exaggerated response may indicate an upper motor-neuron lesion above the pons.

### **Jugular Venous Pressure (JVP)**

The height of the jugular venous column above the right atrium, used clinically as an indirect estimate of right atrial pressure and fluid status.

#### **Synonyms:**

JVP

### **Janus Kinase**

A family of intracellular tyrosine kinases, including JAK1, JAK2, JAK3, and TYK2, that transmit signals from many cytokine and hormone receptors through the JAK-STAT pathway. JAK inhibitors are used for selected inflammatory, hematologic, and other diseases.

### **Jaw**

The upper and lower bony structures of the mouth—the maxilla and mandible—which support

the teeth and contribute to chewing, speech, facial shape, and the oral airway.

### **Jaw Neoplasm**

A neoplasm arising in the jawbone or adjacent oral and facial tissues. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Jeb Protocol**

An experimental oncology treatment protocol; its exact medicines, schedule, indication, and safety profile depend on the study or institution using the name.

### **Jejunal Fistula**

An abnormal connection involving the jejunum and another organ, skin, or body surface. It may cause intestinal contents to leak, infection, malnutrition, dehydration, or sepsis and requires assessment of its cause and output.

### **Jejunal Hemorrhage**

Bleeding from the jejunum, the middle segment of the small intestine, which may cause maroon or black stool, anemia, abdominal pain, or shock depending on its rate and cause.

### **Jejunal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm arising in the jejunum, the middle part of the small intestine. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Jejunal Stenosis**

Narrowing of the jejunal lumen that can impede intestinal contents and cause cramping, vomiting, distension, malabsorption, or obstruction; causes include Crohn disease, adhesions, tumors, and ischemic injury.

### **Jejunal Ulcer**

An ulcerated break in the lining of the jejunum, caused by inflammation, infection, ischemia, medicines, tumor, or anastomotic disease and po-

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tentially producing pain, bleeding, or perforation.

### **Jeotgalibacillus**

Jeotgalibacillus is a genus of Gram-positive, usually halotolerant bacteria reported mainly from salt-rich or fermented environments; isolation from a clinical specimen must be distinguished from contamination or colonization.

### **Johnsonella**

johnsonella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Johnsonella Ignava**

A biomedical term referring to johnsonella ignava; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Joint Capsule**

joint capsule refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Jugular Foramen**

An opening at the base of the skull transmitting the internal jugular vein and cranial nerves IX, X, and XI. Lesions in this region can cause swallowing difficulty, hoarseness, shoulder weakness, hearing symptoms, or other neurologic deficits.

### **Junctional Nevus**

junctional nevus is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Jumper's Knee**

Alternate index label; see *Patellar tendinitis*.

### **Juvenile Schizophrenia**

Alternate index label; see *Childhood schizophrenia*.

### **Jack-In-The-Pulpit Poisoning**

Jack-in-the-pulpit poisoning follows ingestion of calcium oxalate crystals from the plant, causing intense burning and swelling of the mouth, throat, and gastrointestinal tract.

### **Jaundice And Breastfeeding**

Jaundice associated with breastfeeding may reflect inadequate milk intake in the early days or persistent breast-milk jaundice after other serious causes have been excluded.

### **Jaundice Causes**

Jaundice causes include hemolysis, inherited bilirubin disorders, hepatitis, medication or toxin injury, and obstruction of bile drainage; evaluation distinguishes unconjugated from conjugated hyperbilirubinemia.

### **Jejunostomy Feeding Tube**

A jejunostomy feeding tube delivers nutrition directly into the jejunum when oral or gastric feeding is unsafe or inadequate, with attention to formula, rate, position, and complications.

### **Jerusalem Cherry Poisoning**

Jerusalem cherry poisoning follows ingestion of Solanum pseudocapsicum berries, which contain toxic compounds that may cause gastrointestinal symptoms, confusion, weakness, or cardiac effects.

### **Jet Lag Prevention**

Jet lag prevention uses timed light exposure, sleep adjustment, hydration, and carefully planned activity or melatonin strategies to shift the circadian rhythm across time zones.

### **Jewelry Cleaner Poisoning**

Jewelry cleaner poisoning can injure the mouth, esophagus, stomach, lungs, or eyes depending on the product and exposure route; immediate poison-control guidance is appropriate.

### **Jimsonweed Poisoning**

Jimsonweed poisoning causes anticholinergic toxic-

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ity, including dilated pupils, dry mouth, rapid heart rate, urinary retention, agitation, delirium, seizures, or coma.

### **Joint Fluid Culture**

Joint fluid culture tests synovial fluid for bacterial, fungal, or other organisms when septic arthritis is suspected; results are interpreted with cell count, crystals, and clinical findings.

### **Joint Fluid Gram Stain**

Joint fluid Gram stain applies differential staining to synovial fluid to look for bacteria, helping evaluate septic arthritis alongside culture and fluid analysis.

### **Joint X-Ray**

A joint x-ray uses ionizing radiation to assess alignment, fractures, degenerative change, erosions, calcification, and selected soft-tissue or bone abnormalities.

### **Jaundice In Adults**

Adult jaundice is yellowing of skin or eyes from elevated bilirubin due to red-cell breakdown, liver injury, impaired bile flow, or inherited metabolism. Dark urine, pale stool, abdominal pain, fever, confusion, or rapid onset requires prompt assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Adults Jaundice (Jaundice In Adults)

### **Joint Inflammation (Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Arthritis.

### **Jacksonian Seizure**

A focal motor seizure that begins in one body part and may spread in an orderly pattern to adjacent body regions; awareness may remain intact at first.

### **Jammed Finger**

A finger injury caused by sudden force, often involving a sprain, joint dislocation, fracture, or tendon injury; persistent deformity, severe pain, or inability to move requires assessment.

### **JIP**

Abbreviation for juvenile intestinal polyposis, an inherited condition in which children develop multiple hamartomatous polyps in the gastrointestinal tract and may have increased cancer risk.

### **Johnny**

A colloquial term for a hospital gown, usually a short gown that ties in the back; in some regional slang it can also mean a condom.

### **Juxta-**

A prefix meaning next to, beside, or adjoining, as in juxtaglomerular.

### **Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis (JIA)**

A group of inflammatory arthritides beginning before age 16 and lasting at least six weeks, sometimes affecting the eyes or growth.

### **Jacksonian Epilepsy**

Jacksonian epilepsy is a focal motor seizure that spreads in an orderly pattern across adjacent body regions as abnormal activity propagates through the motor cortex.

### **Jadassohn's Naevus**

Jadassohn's naevus is a congenital hairless skin lesion, usually a sebaceous naevus, that may change during life and rarely develop secondary tumors.

### **Jaktitation**

Jaktitation is restless, repetitive, or jerky movement, especially during severe illness or delirium; it is a descriptive historical term rather than a specific diagnosis.

### **Jejunitis**

Jejunitis is inflammation of the jejunum, which may result from infection, inflammatory bowel disease, ischemia, medication, or other intestinal disorders.

### **Jendrassik's Maneuver**

Jendrassik's maneuver reinforces deep-tendon reflexes by having the patient interlock and pull the

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hands or tense another muscle group.

### **Jervell And Lange-Nielsen Syndrome**

Jervell and Lange-Nielsen syndrome is an inherited disorder combining congenital profound sensorineural deafness with prolonged QT and risk of life-threatening ventricular arrhythmia.

### **Jet Lag**

Jet lag is temporary circadian-rhythm disruption after rapid travel across time zones, causing sleep disturbance, fatigue, impaired concentration, and gastrointestinal symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Desynchronosis (Jet Lag)

### **Jod-Basedow Phenomenon**

The Jod-Basedow phenomenon is iodine-induced hyperthyroidism, usually in people with autonomous thyroid tissue exposed to excess iodine.

### **Joint Mice**

Joint mice are loose bodies within a joint, consisting of cartilage, bone, or other tissue that can cause catching, locking, pain, or swelling.

### **Jondice**

Jondice is a misspelling or variant form of jaundice, the yellow discoloration caused by elevated bilirubin in blood and tissues.

### **Jugular**

Jugular means relating to the neck, especially the jugular veins that drain blood from the head and brain to the heart.

### **Jungian Analysis**

Jungian analysis is a psychotherapy approach based on Carl Jung's theories, using exploration of unconscious processes, symbols, dreams, and personality development.

### **Hypermobility Syndrome**

Excessive joint movement associated with pain, instability, fatigue, or other symptoms; evaluation

distinguishes generalized joint hypermobility from a defined hypermobility spectrum disorder or hypermobile Ehlers-Danlos syndrome.

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### Kallmann Syndrome

Congenital form of hypogonadotropic hypogonadism caused by failure of GnRH neuron migration from the olfactory placode to the hypothalamus during embryonic development. Characterized by delayed puberty with low LH and FSH and anosmia or hyposmia from olfactory bulb hypoplasia.

### Keratinocytes

The predominant cells of the epidermis that produce keratin and form the skin's protective barrier.

### Kangaroo Care (Skin-To-Skin Contact)

Holding a newborn directly against a caregiver's bare chest while monitoring the infant's condition. It supports thermal regulation, physiologic stability, bonding, and feeding, and is particularly useful for many preterm or low-birth-weight infants.

#### Synonyms:

Skin-to-Skin Contact

### Kaposi Sarcoma

A vascular tumor caused by human herpesvirus 8 (HHV-8), presenting as violaceous plaques and nodules on skin and mucous membranes. Four types: classic (elderly Mediterranean men), endemic (African), iatrogenic (immunosuppression post-transplant), and AIDS-associated. Cutaneous lesions are the most common presentation in AIDS.

### Kaposi's Sarcoma

A vascular tumor associated with human herpesvirus 8. It may cause purple or reddish skin lesions and can involve internal organs, especially in people with impaired immunity.

### Karnofsky Performance Status

The Karnofsky Performance Status (KPS) scale is a widely used clinical tool for assessing the functional status of patients, particularly those with cancer, and quantifies the patient's ability to perform activities of daily living and tolerate treatments.

### Kartagener Syndrome

A subset of primary ciliary dyskinesia with situs inversus, chronic sinusitis, and bronchiectasis. Caused by dynein defects impairing both mucociliary clearance and embryonic nodal cilia rotation.

### Kartagener Triad

The combination of situs inversus, chronic sinusitis, and bronchiectasis caused by primary ciliary dyskinesia. The underlying ciliary defect impairs mucociliary clearance and embryonic left-right development.

### Karyotype

Display of chromosomes arranged in pairs, ordered by size and banding pattern. Used to detect chromosomal abnormalities. Resolution: 5-10 Mb.

### Karyotyping

Karyotyping examines the number and structure of chromosomes in cells to identify aneuploidy, large rearrangements, and selected chromosomal causes of disease. set of chromosomes, arranged in pairs by size, centromere position, and banding pattern.

### Katz Index

A scale that assesses independence in six basic activities of daily living: bathing, dressing, toileting, transferring, continence, and feeding.

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## Kawasaki Disease

An acute inflammatory disease of childhood that can affect the coronary arteries. It commonly causes persistent fever, rash, conjunctival redness, mouth or extremity changes, and swollen lymph nodes; diagnosis is clinical and incomplete forms occur.

### Synonyms:

Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome (Kawasaki Disease)

## Kawasaki's Disease

An acute, self-limited systemic vasculitis of childhood, also known as mucocutaneous lymph node syndrome, primarily affecting medium-sized arteries with a predilection for the coronary arteries.

### Synonyms:

mucocutaneous.

## Kayser-Fleischer Rings

Golden-brown copper deposits in Descemet membrane of the cornea. They strongly support Wilson disease in the appropriate clinical setting, but may occur in other cholestatic disorders and can be absent in isolated hepatic disease. They are identified by slit-lamp examination and present in virtually all patients with neurological manifestations of Wilson disease though they may be absent in isolated hepatic disease.

## Kearns-Sayre Syndrome

A mitochondrial cytopathy caused by large-scale mitochondrial DNA deletions or rearrangements. It classically begins before age 20 with progressive external ophthalmoplegia, pigmentary retinopathy, and cardiac-conduction disease, and may involve endocrine or neurological systems.

## Kegel

A pelvic-floor muscle contraction exercise used to improve pelvic-floor strength and control of selected types of urinary or fecal incontinence.

## Kegel Exercise

Repeated contraction and relaxation of the pelvic-floor muscles to improve their strength and coordination.

## Keloid

An overgrowth of scar tissue extending beyond the original wound margins, caused by excessive collagen deposition during wound healing. Keloids are more common in darker skin types (Fitzpatrick IV to VI) and occur at sites of trauma, surgery, piercings, and burns. They are pruritic and painful.

### Synonyms:

Scar Excessive (Keloid)

## Keratinocyte

The predominant cell of the epidermis, producing keratin and contributing to the skin's barrier and immune functions.

## Keratitis

Inflammation of the cornea. Infectious keratitis: bacterial (contact lens wear, trauma: *Pseudomonas*, *Staph aureus*), viral (HSV, VZV, adenovirus), fungal (*Candida*, *Fusarium*, *Aspergillus*), and *Acanthamoeba* (contact lens-related). Presents with eye pain, photophobia, tearing, conjunctival injection, and corneal opacity/ulcer.

### Synonyms:

Corneal Inflammation (Keratitis)

## Keratoacanthoma

A low-grade or well-differentiated variant of squamous cell carcinoma (SCC) originating from hair follicles. Characterized by rapid growth over 4-6 weeks into a dome-shaped, flesh-colored or erythematous nodular lesion with a central keratin-filled crater. Often resolves spontaneously over months via involution, leaving a depressed scar.

## Keratoconjunctivitis Sicca

Chronic dryness and inflammation of the cornea and conjunctiva, commonly called dry-eye syndrome. Symptoms include burning, grittiness, redness, fluctuating vision, and light sensitivity; causes include reduced tear production, excessive evaporation, medicines, and autoimmune disease.

### Synonyms:

dry-eye.



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## Keratoconus

Keratoconus is progressive thinning and cone-shaped deformation of the cornea, causing irregular astigmatism, blurred vision, glare, and contact-lens intolerance. percent of cases) thinning and cone-like protrusion of the cornea, leading to irregular astigmatism, myopia, and decreased visual acuity.

## Keratoderma

A group of disorders characterised by excessive thickening of the skin of the palms and soles, which may be hereditary or acquired. Acquired forms can be diffuse, focal, or punctate and may be associated with systemic diseases, malignancy, or medications.

## Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum

A keratoderma associated with reactive arthritis (formerly Reiter syndrome), characterised by waxy, yellowish, vesiculopustular papules and plaques on the palms and soles that may coalesce and extend to the extremities. It mimics pustular psoriasis histologically and clinically.

## Keratoderma Blenorrhagicum

Alternate spelling of keratoderma blennorrhagicum, a cutaneous manifestation of reactive arthritis with waxy, crusty, vesiculopustular lesions on the palms and soles. It is a reactive phenomenon typically occurring in the context of genitourinary or gastrointestinal infection.

## Keratoplasty

Surgical transplantation or reshaping of corneal tissue. Penetrating keratoplasty replaces the full corneal thickness, whereas lamellar techniques replace selected layers and may reduce rejection and recovery time.

## Keratoprosthesis

Artificial cornea for severe corneal blindness. Boston KPro most common. Indications: chemical burns, limbal stem cell deficiency.

## Keratosis Pilaris

A common, benign genetic follicular condition characterized by keratotic follicular papules. Small,

rough, flesh-colored or red bumps on the extensor surfaces of proximal arms, thighs, and sometimes buttocks and face. Caused by abnormal keratinization and plugging of hair follicles with retained keratin.

### Synonyms:

KP

## Kernicterus

Bilirubin encephalopathy resulting from severe unconjugated hyperbilirubinemia (typically greater than 25 mg/dL in term infants). Bilirubin deposits in the basal ganglia, hippocampus, and brainstem nuclei. Presents with lethargy, poor feeding, high-pitched cry, opisthotonus, seizures, and choreoathetosis.

## Kernig Sign

Sign of meningeal irritation. Patient supine, hip and knee flexed 90 degrees; inability to extend knee indicates positive sign. Seen in meningitis, subarachnoid hemorrhage.

## Keshan Disease

Heart disease caused by a lack of selenium, an element that the body needs to function properly.

## Ketogenesis

The production of ketone bodies from fatty acids, mainly in the liver during fasting, prolonged exercise, or inadequate insulin activity.

## Ketogenic Diet

High fat, adequate protein, very low carbohydrate diet (<50g/day). Induces ketosis. Medical uses: epilepsy, obesity, metabolic syndrome. Risks: nutrient deficiency, kidney stones, dyslipidemia.

## Ketone Bodies

Water-soluble molecules produced mainly by the liver from fatty-acid-derived acetyl-CoA during fasting, starvation, prolonged exercise, or insulin deficiency. The principal ketone bodies are acetoacetate, beta-hydroxybutyrate, and acetone.

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## Ketones

Acidic byproducts produced when the body breaks down fat for energy instead of glucose (ketogenesis). Ketones can be detected in blood and urine.

## Ketosis

Metabolic state with elevated ketone bodies. Physiological: fasting, ketogenic diet. Pathological: diabetic ketoacidosis. Distinguish from ketonemia vs ketonuria.

## Kidney

A paired, bean-shaped retroperitoneal organ responsible for filtering blood, excreting waste products as urine, and regulating fluid and electrolyte balance, acid-base homeostasis, and blood pressure (via the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system). Each kidney contains approximately 1 million nephrons, the functional filtering units.

## Kidney And Urinary Health

Kidney and urinary health encompasses the function of the kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra in filtering waste, regulating fluid/electrolyte balance, and eliminating urine.

## Kidney Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the kidney. Renal cell carcinoma is the most common type in adults, but other types occur, especially in children.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Kidney Renal Cancer

## Kidney Failure

The inability of the kidneys to maintain fluid, electrolyte, and acid-base homeostasis and to excrete metabolic wastes. Acute kidney injury (AKI): sudden decline in GFR over hours-days—prerenal (hypoperfusion), intrinsic (acute tubular necrosis, glomerulonephritis, interstitial nephritis), postrenal (obstruction).

### Synonyms:

Renal Failure (Kidney Failure)

## Kidney Function Tests

Blood and urine tests used to assess how well the kidneys filter waste and regulate fluid and electrolytes. Common measures include creatinine, estimated glomerular filtration rate, urine albumin, and urinalysis; results are interpreted with the clinical context.

## Kidney Stone

A hard deposit formed from substances in urine that can obstruct the urinary tract and cause severe flank or abdominal pain.

## Kidney Stones

Kidney stones are crystalline deposits in the urinary tract that can cause colicky flank pain, hematuria, vomiting, obstruction, or infection depending on size and location. affecting approximately 10 percent of the population over a lifetime, with a male-to-female ratio of 2:1 and peak incidence in the 4th-6th decades.

### Synonyms:

Nephrolithiasis (Kidney Stones) Renal Lithiasis

## Kidney Stones (Nephrolithiasis / Urolithiasis)

Crystalline mineral deposits formed within the renal pelvis and calyces due to supersaturation of urine.

### Synonyms:

Nephrolithiasis / Urolithiasis

## Kidney Transplant Rejection

Immune-mediated injury to a transplanted kidney caused by recipient antibodies, T cells, or both. Hyperacute, acute, and chronic rejection differ in timing and pathology and require correlation of graft function, imaging, serology, and often biopsy.

## Kidney Transplantation

Best treatment for ESRD with improved survival over dialysis. Living donor superior to deceased donor. Lifelong immunosuppression required. Rejection types include hyperacute, acute, and chronic. Complications include rejection, infection, vascular complications, and recurrent disease.

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### Kienbock Disease

Kienbock disease (lunatomalacia): AVN of lunate. Lichtman classification: I (normal XR, MRI edema), II (lunate sclerosis), IIIA (lunate collapse, no scaphoid rotation), IIIB (lunate collapse, fixed scaphoid rotation, DISI), IV (perilunate arthritis). Etiology: negative ulnar variance, trauma, vascular variation.

### Kiesselbach Plexus

A network of small arteries on the front part of the nasal septum and a common source of nosebleeds.

### Killian's Triangle

An area of potential weakness in the pharyngeal wall between the thyropharyngeus and cricopharyngeus muscles, predisposing to Zenker diverticulum formation.

### Killip Classification

A clinical classification system for assessing the severity of myocardial infarction based on physical examination findings. Class I: no heart failure signs. Class II: mild heart failure (crackles, S3 gallop, elevated JVD). Class III: pulmonary edema. Class IV: cardiogenic shock.

### Kimmelstiel-Wilson Nodules

Characteristic round eosinophilic nodular mesangial expansions in diabetic nephropathy. Represent advanced mesangial matrix accumulation. Found in peripheral mesangium associated with diffuse mesangial expansion, GBM thickening, and arteriolar hyalinosis.

### Kimura Disease

A chronic inflammatory disorder characterized by painless subcutaneous masses, commonly in the head and neck, regional lymphadenopathy, eosinophilia, and elevated immunoglobulin E. It is distinct from angiolymphoid hyperplasia with eosinophilia and may involve the kidneys.

### Kinesio Taping

Application of an elastic adhesive tape to the skin to provide support or sensory input while allowing

movement. Its clinical benefit varies by condition.

### Kinesiology

The study of human movement and the forces that produce or affect it, with applications in health care, rehabilitation, sport, and ergonomics.

### Kinetic Modeling

Mathematical modeling of how a tracer or drug moves through and is exchanged among tissues or body compartments.

### Kinetics

The study of how a process changes over time. In pharmacology, it includes the absorption, distribution, metabolism, and elimination of a drug.

### Klebsiella Pneumonia

Severe, necrotizing pneumonia in alcoholic or debilitated patients. Upper lobe involvement with "bulging fissure sign" and "currant jelly" sputum.

### Klebsiella Rhinoscleromatis

A gram-negative bacillus causing chronic granulomatous infection of the nasal passages and upper airway, leading to rhinoscleroma with progressive nasal obstruction and tissue destruction.

### Klinefelter Syndrome

Most common sex chromosome aneuploidy in males with a karyotype of 47,XXY occurring in approximately one in six hundred live male births. Characterized by small firm testes, gynecomastia, tall stature with long extremities, and infertility from azoospermia.

### Klippel-Feil Syndrome

A congenital condition characterized by fusion of two or more cervical vertebrae, resulting from failure of normal segmentation of the cervical somites during weeks 3-8 of gestation. Classic triad: short neck, low posterior hairline, and limited cervical range of motion (present in <50% of cases).

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## Klippel-Trenaunay Syndrome

A congenital vascular disorder characterized by the triad: capillary malformations (port-wine stains), venous malformations (varicose veins, persistent embryonic veins), and soft tissue or bone hypertrophy of the affected limb (typically a lower extremity).

## Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber Syndrome

A rare congenital overgrowth disorder involving capillary or venous malformations and enlargement of bone or soft tissue, usually affecting one limb. It may cause limb asymmetry, pain, bleeding, thrombosis, or lymphedema. Care is multidisciplinary and may include compression, vascular treatment, and orthopedic management.

### Synonyms:

Klippel Trenaunay Weber Syndrome (Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber Syndrome)

## Klumpke Paralysis

Lower-trunk brachial-plexus injury affecting primarily the C8 and T1 nerve roots. It causes weakness or paralysis of the intrinsic hand muscles, sensory loss along the medial forearm and hand, and occasionally Horner syndrome when sympathetic fibres are involved.

## Knee Disorders

The knee is a complex hinge-type synovial joint connecting the femur, tibia, and patella, stabilized by ligaments (ACL, PCL, MCL, LCL), menisci (medial and lateral), and surrounding muscles/tendons.

## Knee Joint

A synovial joint formed mainly by the femur, tibia, and patella. It permits flexion and extension with limited rotation and is stabilized by ligaments, menisci, muscles, and the joint capsule.

## Knee Pain

Pain felt in or around the knee, commonly caused by injury, osteoarthritis, bursitis, tendinitis, or inflammatory disease. Persistent swelling, instability, inability to bear weight, or fever requires medical assessment.

### Synonyms:

Pain, Knee

## Knee Prosthesis

An artificial joint component used to replace damaged surfaces of the knee, usually including femoral and tibial components and sometimes a patellar component.

## Kneecap

The largest sesamoid bone in the human body, embedded within the quadriceps tendon anterior to the knee joint. See Patella (Kneecap).

## Kniest Dysplasia

A rare skeletal dysplasia caused most often by pathogenic variants in COL2A1. It produces disproportionate short stature, enlarged joints, progressive joint disease, distinctive facial features, and sometimes severe ocular, auditory, or respiratory complications.

## Knife-Cut Ulcers From Crohn's Disease

Deep, linear, serpiginous ulcerations of the intestinal mucosa in Crohn disease, resembling cuts made by a knife. These longitudinal ulcers with heaped-up margins are characteristic of Crohn disease and help distinguish it from ulcerative colitis on endoscopy. They may cause strictures, fistulae, and bleeding.

## Knock Knees

Medial angulation of the knees causing the knees to touch while the ankles remain apart, also called genu valgum. It is common during childhood development but may be pathologic when severe, asymmetric, persistent, or associated with pain or growth disturbance.

### Synonyms:

genu valgum.

## Knotless Anchor

Suture anchor for soft tissue repair without tying knots. Used in orthopedic surgery.

## KOH Preparation

Microscopic examination of skin, hair, or nail scrap-

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ings treated with potassium hydroxide to dissolve keratin and reveal fungal hyphae or yeast. A negative preparation does not exclude infection when sampling is inadequate or prior treatment has been given.

### **Koilonychia**

Spoon nails: nails with a concave (spoon-shaped) contour, most commonly associated with iron deficiency anemia; also seen in hemochromatosis, Plummer-Vinson syndrome, malnutrition, and trauma (nail dystrophy). The nail becomes thin, brittle, and turns up at the edges so a drop of water rests in the concavity.

### **Koplik Spots**

A characteristic enanthem of measles. It consists of small, bluish-white spots on an erythematous bluish-white spots on an erythematous background located on the buccal mucosa opposite the lower molars ("grains of salt on a red background"). Appear 1-2 days prior to the onset of the maculopapular rash and disappear 1-2 days after rash onset.

### **Krabbe Disease**

An autosomal-recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient galactocerebrosidase activity and accumulation of psychosine. Infantile disease causes irritability, stiffness, developmental regression, seizures, and progressive loss of neurological function; later-onset forms are variable.

### **Kt/V**

Dialysis adequacy measure representing the fractional clearance of urea. K is dialyzer clearance, t is treatment time, V is volume of distribution of urea. Target Kt/V greater than 1.4 for thrice-weekly hemodialysis. Urea reduction ratio greater than 70% is alternative adequacy measure.

### **Kussmaul Breathing**

A deep, rapid breathing pattern seen in severe metabolic acidosis (diabetic ketoacidosis, lactic acidosis, uremia). It represents the body's attempt to compensate by blowing off CO<sub>2</sub>. The increased respiratory rate and depth create the characteristic

labored breathing.

### **Kussmaul Sign**

Paradoxical increase in jugular venous pressure with inspiration, normally the JVP decreases with inspiration. It indicates impaired right ventricular filling during inspiration. Seen in constrictive pericarditis, restrictive cardiomyopathy, severe right heart failure, cardiac tamponade, and massive pulmonary embolism.

### **Kwashiorkor**

Kwashiorkor is severe protein-energy malnutrition characterized by edema, growth failure, muscle wasting, skin or hair changes, and impaired immune function. deficiency relative to calorie intake (often occurring in children when weaned from breast milk to a high-carbohydrate starch diet).

### **Kyphoplasty**

A medical term referring to kyphoplasty. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Kyphoscoliosis**

An abnormal curvature of the spine in both the coronal (scoliosis) and sagittal (kyphosis) planes. Severe forms cause restrictive lung disease by reducing chest wall compliance and lung volumes. It can lead to chronic respiratory failure and pulmonary hypertension.

### **Kyphosis**

Kyphosis is excessive forward curvature of the thoracic spine, which may result from posture, vertebral compression, developmental conditions, degeneration, or inflammatory disease. angle on lateral spine x-ray (normal thoracic kyphosis is 20-40 degrees).

#### **Synonyms:**

Round Back

### **Keratectomy**

Surgical removal or reshaping of part of the cornea, often to correct vision.

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### **Keratoderma Blennorrhagica**

Thickened, scaly skin lesions associated with reactive arthritis.

### **Kaposi's Sarcoma**

A cancer of blood-vessel or lymphatic-vessel lining cells, often associated with human herpesvirus 8.

### **Kidney Calculi**

Solid mineral deposits that form in the kidneys; also called kidney stones.

#### **Synonyms:**

kidney stones.

### **Klinefelter's Syndrome**

A chromosomal condition in which a male has one or more extra X chromosomes, often causing small testes and reduced fertility.

### **Krabbe's Disease**

A rare inherited disorder in which loss of myelin progressively damages the nervous system.

### **Krukenberg Tumor**

An ovarian tumor caused by metastatic cancer, commonly originating in the stomach or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Kuru**

Kuru is a rare fatal prion disease historically associated with ritual cannibalism, causing progressive ataxia, tremor, and neurologic decline.

### **Kidney Position**

A modified lateral position in which the operating table is flexed at the waist to elevate the flank and improve access to the kidney or retroperitoneum.

### **Knee-Chest Position**

A position in which the patient rests on the knees and chest, with the hips flexed; it may be used for spinal or anorectal procedures.

### **Keloid Scar**

A raised scar caused by excessive growth of scar

tissue after skin injury.

### **Kidney Infection**

An infection of one or both kidneys, usually caused by bacteria that spread from the urinary tract.

### **Kleptomania**

A mental health disorder marked by repeated inability to resist urges to steal items that are not needed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Compulsive Stealing Pathological Stealing

### **Keratin**

A tough structural protein found in skin, hair, nails, and other epithelial tissues.

### **Keratometer**

An instrument that measures the curvature of the cornea.

### **Kinesthesia**

The sense of movement and position of the body's parts.

### **Kussmaul Respiration**

Deep, rapid breathing commonly associated with severe metabolic acidosis, especially diabetic ketoacidosis.

### **Kelly Clamp**

A hinged surgical clamp used to grasp tissue or compress blood vessels and control bleeding.

### **Kocher Clamp**

A toothed surgical clamp used to hold firm tissue or clamp vessels.

### **Kidney Transplant**

Surgical placement of a healthy donor kidney into a person with kidney failure to restore renal function. Lifelong immunosuppressive treatment is generally required to reduce rejection risk.



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### **Korsakoff Syndrome**

A chronic amnestic disorder caused most often by severe thiamine deficiency associated with alcohol-use disorder. It causes impaired formation of new memories, loss of past memories, and sometimes confabulation.

### **Kala-Azar (Visceral Leishmaniasis)**

A serious parasitic infection caused by Leishmania species and transmitted by sandflies. It may cause prolonged fever, weight loss, enlargement of the spleen and liver, and suppression of blood-cell production.

#### **Synonyms:**

Visceral Leishmaniasis

### **Katayama Fever (Acute Schistosomiasis)**

An acute systemic reaction to schistosome infection, usually occurring weeks after exposure and causing fever, rash, cough, abdominal symptoms, and eosinophilia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Acute Schistosomiasis

### **Keratolysis**

Breakdown or loss of keratinized tissue, especially the superficial layer of the skin; it may occur in some infections and inflammatory skin disorders.

### **Keratomalacia**

Softening and ulceration of the cornea caused most often by severe vitamin A deficiency, potentially leading to blindness.

### **Kerion**

An inflamed, boggy, pus-forming mass caused by a fungal infection of hair-bearing skin, usually a severe form of tinea capitis.

### **Ketoacidosis**

A metabolic emergency in which excessive ketone production causes acidosis, most commonly in diabetic ketoacidosis.

### **Ketonuria (Acetonuria)**

The presence of ketone bodies in the urine, occurring in conditions such as diabetic ketoacidosis, prolonged fasting, or severe vomiting.

#### **Synonyms:**

Acetonuria

### **Kinase**

An enzyme that transfers a phosphate group, usually from ATP, to another molecule; kinases regulate many cellular processes.

### **Klebsiella**

A genus of Gram-negative bacteria that can cause pneumonia, urinary-tract infection, bloodstream infection, and other healthcare-associated infections.

### **Koch's Bacillus (Mycobacterium Tuberculosis)**

The bacterium that causes tuberculosis, an infection most often affecting the lungs but capable of involving many organs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mycobacterium Tuberculosis

### **Korotkoff Sounds**

Sounds heard through a stethoscope over an artery as a blood-pressure cuff is deflated; their appearance and disappearance are used to estimate systolic and diastolic pressure.

### **Krebs Cycle (Citric Acid Cycle)**

A series of chemical reactions in mitochondria that oxidizes acetyl-CoA and generates energy-rich molecules used for cellular energy production.

#### **Synonyms:**

Citric Acid Cycle

### **Kulchitsky Cells (Enterochromaffin Cells)**

Specialized neuroendocrine cells, especially in the gastrointestinal and respiratory tracts, that release signalling substances such as serotonin.

#### **Synonyms:**

Enterochromaffin Cells

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## Kanamycin

Kanamycin is an aminoglycoside antibiotic that binds the bacterial 30S ribosomal subunit and causes misreading of mRNA; it is used selectively for susceptible serious infections and can cause nephrotoxicity and irreversible ototoxicity.

## Karyomegaly

Karyomegaly is abnormal enlargement of a cell nucleus, often reflecting cellular injury, regeneration, infection, toxic exposure, or neoplasia; its significance depends on the tissue and accompanying microscopic changes.

## Karyometry

karyometry is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## Karyotype Result

karyotype result is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## Keratan Sulfate

Keratan sulfate is a sulfated glycosaminoglycan found especially in cornea, cartilage, and brain; impaired breakdown causes accumulation in some mucopolysaccharidoses and can produce skeletal or ocular disease.

## Keratoconjunctivitis

Keratoconjunctivitis is inflammation of both the cornea and conjunctiva, caused by infection, allergy, dryness, immune disease, or chemical injury.

## Keratocyte Count

A keratocyte count estimates the number or density of stromal cells in the cornea, usually by microscopy or imaging; it may help assess corneal injury, inflammation, degeneration, or response to surgery.

## Keratosis

Keratosis is a thickened or abnormal growth of keratinized skin and may be benign, inflammatory, infectious, or premalignant.

## Keratosis Follicularis

Keratosis follicularis is excessive keratinization around hair follicles, producing rough follicular papules; it may refer to keratosis pilaris or, in some contexts, inherited follicular keratosis disorders.

## Kerstersia Gyiorum

A biomedical term referring to *kerstersia gyiorum*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Ketamine

Ketamine is a dissociative anaesthetic and NMDA-receptor antagonist used for anaesthesia, procedural sedation, and selected treatment-resistant depression; emergence reactions, increased blood pressure, nausea, misuse, and respiratory complications are possible.

## Ketamine Hydrochloride

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ketamine hydrochloride. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## Ketanserin

A selective serotonin 5-HT<sub>2</sub>-receptor antagonist formerly used in some countries for hypertension and studied for vascular and platelet effects; availability and clinical use are limited and adverse effects may include dizziness and hypotension.

## Keto Acid

A biological or biochemical term involving keto acid. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Ketoconazole

Ketoconazole is an imidazole antifungal that inhibits

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fungal ergosterol synthesis; topical forms treat superficial mycoses, while oral use is restricted because of potentially severe liver injury, adrenal suppression, and drug interactions.

### **Ketone**

A ketone is an organic compound containing a carbonyl group between two carbon atoms; medically important ketone bodies include acetoacetate, beta-hydroxybutyrate, and acetone, which rise during fasting or diabetic ketoacidosis.

### **Ketonuria**

Ketonuria is the presence of ketone bodies in urine, occurring with fasting, vomiting, low-carbohydrate intake, pregnancy, or uncontrolled diabetes; marked ketonuria with hyperglycaemia may indicate diabetic ketoacidosis.

### **Ketoprofen**

A non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drug that inhibits cyclo-oxygenase and reduces pain, inflammation, and fever; gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, cardiovascular events, and hypersensitivity are important risks.

### **Ketorolac**

A potent non-steroidal anti-inflammatory analgesic used for short-term management of moderate-to-severe acute pain; treatment duration is restricted because gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, and impaired healing can occur.

### **Ketorolac Tromethamine**

The tromethamine salt of ketorolac, a potent non-steroidal anti-inflammatory analgesic used short term for moderate-to-severe acute pain; it is contraindicated in several bleeding, renal, pregnancy, and perioperative situations.

### **Ketotic Hypoglycemia**

Ketotic hypoglycemia is low blood glucose with ketones after fasting or illness, often occurring in young children and usually improving with age.

### **Ketotifen**

An antihistamine with mast-cell-stabilizing activity used in some countries for allergic disorders and, in ophthalmic form, allergic conjunctivitis; drowsiness, increased appetite, and irritation may occur.

### **Kidney Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving kidney neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Kinesin**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinesin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kinesis**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinesis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kinesthesia**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinesthesia. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kinetochore**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinetochore. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kinetosome**

A kinetosome is a basal body that organizes the microtubules of a cilium or flagellum.

### **Kingella**

kingella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Kingella Denitrificans**

kingella denitrificans is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection.

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tion rather than colonization.

### **Kingella Kingae**

kingella kingae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Kingella Oralis**

kingella oralis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Kingella Potus**

kingella potus is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Kinin**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kininogenase**

A biological or biochemical term involving kininogenase. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kinocilium**

A biological or biochemical term involving kinocilium. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kit Device**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving kit device. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Klatskin Tumor**

A neoplasm involving klatskin tumor. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Klebsiella Oxytoca**

klebsiella oxytoca is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Klebsiella Pneumoniae**

klebsiella pneumoniae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Klebsiella Singaporensis**

klebsiella singaporensis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Klebsiella Variicola**

klebsiella variicola is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Kluyvera**

A biomedical term referring to kluyvera; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kluyvera Ascorbata**

A biomedical term referring to kluyvera ascorbata; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kluyvera Cryocrescens**

A biomedical term referring to kluyvera cryocrescens; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kluyvera Georgiana**

A biomedical term referring to kluyvera georgiana; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic

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context.

### **Kluyvera Intermedia**

A biomedical term referring to *kluyvera intermedia*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kluyveromyces**

*kluyveromyces* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Kluyveromyces Lactis**

*kluyveromyces lactis* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Kluyveromyces Marxianus**

*kluyveromyces marxianus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Knee**

The synovial joint between the femur, tibia, and patella, stabilized by the cruciate and collateral ligaments and menisci; it permits flexion and extension and bears body weight.

### **Knoellia**

A biomedical term referring to *knoellia*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Knuckle Pad**

A knuckle pad is a firm thickening over a finger joint, usually benign and associated with friction, trauma, or fibromatosis.

### **Kocuria**

A biomedical term referring to *kocuria*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kocuria Rosea**

A biomedical term referring to *kocuria rosea*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kocuria Varians**

A biomedical term referring to *kocuria varians*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kodamaea Ohmeri**

A biomedical term referring to *kodamaea ohmeri*; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **KRAS Gene**

KRAS encodes a small GTPase that relays signals from growth-factor receptors through the RAS–RAF–MEK–ERK pathway; activating mutations drive cancers and can predict resistance to some targeted therapies.

### **Krebs' Cycle**

The Krebs cycle, or citric-acid cycle, is a mitochondrial pathway that oxidizes acetyl-CoA to carbon dioxide and generates NADH, FADH<sub>2</sub>, and GTP for oxidative phosphorylation.

### **Kringles**

A biological or biochemical term involving kringles. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kupffer's Cell**

A Kupffer cell is a resident macrophage lining the liver sinusoids; it removes microbes, damaged blood cells, and particles from portal blood and con-

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tributes to hepatic inflammation and iron handling.

### **Kurthia**

A biomedical term referring to kurthia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Kynurenine**

A biological or biochemical term involving kynurenine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Kytococcus**

kytrococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Kytococcus Sedentarius**

kytrococcus sedentarius is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Kidney Pain**

Pain felt in the side or back below the ribs that may be caused by kidney stones, infection, obstruction, inflammation, or referred pain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain Kidney (Kidney Pain)

### **Knee Pain: Symptom**

Pain in or around the knee caused by injury, overuse, arthritis, inflammation, infection, or other joint or soft-tissue disorders.

### **Keratosis, Actinic**

Alternate index label; see *Actinic keratosis*.

### **Keratosis, Seborrheic**

Alternate index label; see *Seborrheic keratosis*.

### **Ketoacidosis, Diabetic**

Alternate index label; see *Diabetic ketoacidosis*.

### **Kidney Disease, Chronic**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic kidney disease*.

### **Kidney Failure, Chronic**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic kidney disease*.

### **Kissing Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Mononucleosis*.

### **KP**

Alternate index label; see *Keratosis pilaris*.

### **Keeping Your Medicines Organized**

Medicine organization uses an accurate list, labeled containers, schedules, pillboxes when appropriate, refill planning, and review for duplication or interactions.

### **Kegel Exercises - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to kegel exercises - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Keloids**

Keloids are raised scars that extend beyond the original wound because of excessive collagen deposition and may cause itching, pain, or cosmetic concern.

### **Keratosis Obturans**

Keratosis obturans is accumulation of shed keratin blocking the external ear canal, causing pain, hearing loss, and canal widening.

### **Kerosene Poisoning**

Kerosene poisoning involves toxic exposure to kerosene poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.



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### **Ketones Blood Test**

Ketones blood test examines ketones blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Ketones Urine Test**

Ketones urine test examines ketones urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Ketoprofen Overdose**

Ketoprofen overdose involves toxic exposure to ketoprofen overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Kidney Biopsy**

Kidney biopsy examines kidney biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Kidney Disease - Resources**

A clinical condition involving kidney Disease - Resources; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Kidney Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to kidney removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Kidney Removal - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to kidney removal - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Kidney Stones - Self-Care**

Kidney-stone self-care may include prescribed pain control, hydration when safe, straining urine, and follow-up; fever, anuria, or severe pain needs urgent care.

### **Kidney Stones - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Questions about kidney stones should cover size, location, composition, obstruction, infection, treatment options, prevention, testing, and warning symptoms.

### **Kidney Stones And Lithotripsy - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to kidney stones and lithotripsy - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Kinins**

A group of vasoactive peptides, chiefly bradykinin and kallidin, generated from kininogens during inflammation; they promote vasodilation, increased vascular permeability, smooth-muscle effects, and pain.

### **Knee Arthroscopy**

Knee arthroscopy is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Knee Arthroscopy - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to knee arthroscopy - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Knee Braces - Unloading**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving knee braces - unloading. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Knee CT Scan**

Knee CT scan examines knee ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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## **Knee Joint Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to knee joint replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Knee Joint Replacement - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to knee joint replacement - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Knee Microfracture Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to knee microfracture surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Knee MRI Scan**

Knee MRI scan examines knee mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Kneecap Dislocation**

A kneecap dislocation occurs when the patella moves out of its femoral groove, usually laterally, causing pain, deformity, swelling, and difficulty walking.

## **Kneecap Dislocation - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to kneecap dislocation - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Kahlers Disease (Multiple Myeloma)**

Alternate index label for Multiple Myeloma.

## **Keratoconjunctivitis Sicca (Dry Eyes)**

Alternate index label for Dry Eyes.

## **KetoacidosisDiabetic (Diabetic Ketoacidosis)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Ketoacidosis.

## **Kidney Pain Vs. Back Pain**

Kidney pain is usually felt in the flank beneath the ribs and may accompany urinary symptoms, fever, nausea, or blood in the urine. Back pain more often changes with movement or position; severe pain, fever, weakness, or urinary change needs assessment.

## **Kids Depression (Depression In Children)**

Alternate index label for Depression in Children.

## **Killer Cold Virus (Adenovirus Infection, Ad14)**

Alternate index label for Adenovirus Infection, Ad14.

## **Klippel Trenaunay Weber Syndrome (Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber Syndrome.

## **Knee And Ankle Pain After Hip Replacement**

Knee or ankle pain after hip replacement may reflect altered gait and muscle loading, nerve irritation, swelling, a stress injury, infection, or a blood clot. New severe pain, calf swelling, fever, wound drainage, or breathlessness requires prompt evaluation.

## **Knee Bursitis**

Knee bursitis is inflammation of a fluid-filled sac around the knee, causing localized swelling, tenderness, and pain with kneeling or movement. Repetitive pressure, trauma, arthritis, gout, or infection can contribute; fever or redness requires urgent review.

### **Synonyms:**

Bursitis Of The Knee

## **Knee Injury And Meniscus Tears**

A meniscus tear is damage to the cartilage cushion between the thighbone and shinbone, often after twisting or with degeneration. Pain, swelling, catching, or locking may occur; treatment ranges from rehabilitation to surgery according to tear, symp-

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toms, and stability.

### **Knee Pain Facts**

Knee pain can arise from ligament or meniscus injury, arthritis, bursitis, tendon disease, gout, infection, nerve disease, or referred hip or spine pain. Deformity, inability to bear weight, fever, a locked joint, or sudden swelling needs assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain Knee (Knee Pain Facts)

### **Kyphosis Vs Lordosis Differences And Similarities**

Kyphosis is excessive backward curvature of the upper spine, while lordosis is excessive inward curvature, usually in the lower spine. Both may be postural or structural and can result from growth disorders, fractures, degeneration, or muscle imbalance.

### **K (Potassium)**

The chemical symbol for potassium, a major intracellular electrolyte needed for nerve signaling, muscle contraction, and cardiac electrical activity.

### **Kala-Azar**

Visceral leishmaniasis, a potentially fatal parasitic infection affecting internal organs such as the spleen, liver, and bone marrow, usually transmitted by sandflies.

### **Kalemia**

A suffix or term referring to the concentration of potassium in the blood, as in hypokalemia or hyperkalemia.

### **Karyocyte**

A cell that contains a nucleus; the term is used especially when distinguishing nucleated cells from cells without nuclei.

### **Karyokinesis**

Division of a cell nucleus during cell division, producing two daughter nuclei with organized sets of chromosomes.

### **Kashin-Beck Disease**

A chronic osteoarticular disorder causing pain, stiffness, deformity, and growth abnormalities, associated particularly with selenium deficiency and environmental factors in endemic regions.

### **KB**

In medical usage, an abbreviation for keratoderma blennorrhagicum or kilobase of DNA; lower-case *kb* is preferred for kilobase, so context is important.

### **Kerato-**

A combining form relating to the cornea or to horny or keratinized tissue, as in keratitis and keratosis.

### **Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum**

Thickened, scaly, or wart-like skin lesions, often on the palms and soles, associated with reactive arthritis and sometimes infection-triggered inflammation.

### **Keratoma**

A localized thickening or tumor-like growth of keratinized skin, such as a callus or corn; the exact type and need for evaluation depend on its appearance and behavior.

### **Kilocalorie**

A unit of energy equal to 1,000 small calories; the dietary Calorie, written with a capital C, is one kilocalorie.

### **Kimmelstiel-Wilson Syndrome**

Nodular glomerulosclerosis caused by long-standing diabetic kidney disease, with thickened glomerular structures, proteinuria, declining kidney function, and possible kidney failure.

### **Kiss**

A touch or caress with the lips; kissing can transmit some infections through saliva or close contact, depending on the pathogen.

### **Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber (KTW) Syndrome**

An older, imprecise label for a congenital vascu-

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lar and limb-overgrowth disorder; modern terminology distinguishes Klippel–Trenaunay syndrome from Parkes Weber syndrome, which includes arteriovenous malformations.

### **Koch's Postulates**

Historical criteria proposed to link a microorganism to a disease, including its presence in affected cases, isolation and culture, reproduction of disease, and re-isolation; molecular and modern infectious-disease methods have expanded beyond these criteria.

### **Koplik's Spots**

Small white or bluish-gray spots on the inner cheek, often with a red base, that are characteristic of measles and may appear shortly before the skin rash.

### **KUB**

Abbreviation for kidney, ureter, and bladder, commonly referring to a plain abdominal X-ray used to assess urinary tract calculi, bowel gas patterns, or other abdominal findings.

### **Kidney Cysts**

Fluid-filled sacs in or on the kidneys that are often harmless but may occasionally cause pain, infection, bleeding, or impaired kidney function.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst, Kidney

### **Kernicterus (Nuclear Jaundice)**

Brain injury caused by deposition of excessive unconjugated bilirubin in the basal ganglia and other brain regions, usually in a severely jaundiced newborn.

### **Kallmann's Syndrome**

Inherited hypogonadotropic hypogonadism caused by deficient gonadotropin-releasing hormone, typically accompanied by reduced or absent sense of smell.

### **Kant's Disease**

An uncommon historical eponym whose precise clinical

meaning varies between sources; the original reference should be checked before using it clinically.

### **Kaolin**

A clay mineral containing hydrated aluminium silicate, used as an adsorbent or protective substance; inhalation of kaolin dust can cause occupational lung disease.

### **Kartagener's Syndrome**

A form of primary ciliary dyskinesia characterized by chronic sinusitis, bronchiectasis, and situs inversus.

### **Keel Breast**

A protruding breastbone and anterior chest-wall deformity, generally referring to pectus carinatum.

### **Keller's Operation**

An excision arthroplasty of the first metatarsophalangeal joint, historically used for hallux rigidus or painful bunion deformity.

### **Keratan Sulphate**

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan found especially in the cornea and cartilage; abnormal accumulation occurs in some mucopolysaccharidoses.

### **Keratolytics**

Substances such as salicylic acid or urea that soften and remove excess keratin from thickened skin, corns, or warts.

### **Kernig's Sign**

Pain or resistance when extending the knee with the hip flexed, a nonspecific clinical sign of meningeal irritation.

### **Kidney, Artificial**

A dialysis device that removes metabolic waste and excess fluid from blood and helps correct electrolyte disturbances when renal function is inadequate.

### **Kidney, Diseases Of**

Disorders affecting the kidneys or urinary collecting system that can impair filtration, urine formation,

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fluid balance, blood pressure, or electrolyte regulation.

### **Kieselguhr**

Diatomaceous earth containing substantial silica; inhalation of its dust can produce occupational pneumoconiosis and other lung injury.

### **Kilojoule**

The SI unit of energy, equal to 1,000 joules; approximately 4.184 kilojoules equal one kilocalorie.

### **Kinetic**

Relating to movement or motion; in clinical usage it may describe movement-related phenomena such as a kinetic tremor.

### **Kinetoplast**

A DNA-containing region of the mitochondrion in certain protozoa, including *Trypanosoma* and *Leishmania*.

### **King-Copeland-Coons Syndrome**

A rare historical eponym whose definition is not consistent across medical references; its source-specific meaning should be verified.

### **Klumpke's Paralysis**

Lower brachial-plexus palsy involving mainly the C8 and T1 nerve roots, causing hand weakness and sensory loss; Horner syndrome may accompany severe cases.

### **Knee-Jerk**

The patellar tendon deep-tendon reflex, in which tapping the tendon produces extension of the knee, chiefly testing the L3-L4 spinal segments.

### **Knock-Knee**

Genu valgum, a leg alignment in which the knees angle inward and may touch while the ankles remain apart.

### **Knuckle**

A projecting finger joint, usually a metacarpophal-

angeal joint; it may be affected by trauma, inflammation, or arthritis.

### **Koch's Bacillus**

*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, the bacterium that causes tuberculosis; the term is a historical eponym.

### **Koebner Phenomenon**

Development of lesions of a skin disease, classically psoriasis or vitiligo, at sites of injury or other trauma.

### **Korsakoff's Syndrome**

A chronic amnesic disorder, commonly associated with severe thiamine deficiency and alcohol-use disorder, causing impaired new learning, memory loss, and sometimes confabulation.

### **Kraurosis**

An older term for atrophic and sclerotic vulvar disease, often referring to lichen sclerosus and associated with itching, discomfort, and tissue fragility.

### **Krunkenberg Tumour**

A misspelled variant of Krukenberg tumour, meaning a metastatic ovarian signet-ring-cell adenocarcinoma, usually originating in the stomach or another gastrointestinal site.

### **Krukenberg's Tumor**

A metastatic ovarian tumour composed commonly of signet-ring cells, most often arising from gastric or other gastrointestinal adenocarcinoma.

### **Kwarshiorkor**

A misspelling of kwashiorkor, a severe protein-energy malnutrition syndrome characterized by oedema, growth failure, muscle wasting, and often fatty liver.

### **Synonyms:**

Nuclear Jaundice

### **Kounis Syndrome**

An acute coronary syndrome caused by an allergic or hypersensitivity reaction, involving coronary va-

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sospasm, plaque erosion or rupture, or stent thrombosis. It may occur with allergic symptoms and requires simultaneous assessment and treatment of the allergic reaction and myocardial ischemia.

### **Koebnerisation**

Development of lesions of an existing skin disease at sites of trauma or injury, classically seen in psoriasis, vitiligo, and lichen planus.



## L

### L

Abbreviation for liter, a metric unit of volume equal to 1,000 milliliters.

### Labor

The process of uterine contractions leading to progressive cervical dilation and effacement and delivery of the fetus. Stages: first (latent—cervical dilation to 3-4 cm, then active—3-10 cm), second (full dilation to delivery of the infant), third (delivery of the placenta), fourth (first hour postpartum).

### Lamellar Bone

Mature, organized bone tissue arranged in layers.

### L-Dopa

A precursor converted to dopamine in the brain, used mainly with carbidopa or benserazide to treat Parkinson disease.

### Labium

A lip-like anatomical structure; in obstetrics and gynecology, usually one of the labia of the vulva.

### Laboratory Medicine

The medical specialty that uses laboratory tests on blood, tissue, and other specimens for diagnosis, screening, monitoring, and treatment.

### Lachrymal

Relating to tears or the structures that produce and drain them; also spelled lacrimal.

### Lacrimal

Relating to tears or the lacrimal glands and drainage

passages.

### La Crosse Encephalitis

A mosquito-borne viral encephalitis caused by La Crosse virus, usually affecting children and causing fever, headache, seizures, or altered consciousness.

### Lacuna

A small space or cavity in tissue, such as a space containing an osteocyte in bone.

### Laennec's Cirrhosis

An older term for alcohol-associated cirrhosis, characterized by diffuse liver fibrosis and regenerative nodules.

### Lagophthalmos

Incomplete closure of the eyelids, which can expose and dry the cornea.

### Lambda

The junction of the sagittal and lambdoid sutures of the skull; it is also a symbol used in medical notation.

### Lamellar

Arranged in thin layers or lamellae.

### Landry's Paralysis

An older name for the rapidly ascending paralysis of Guillain-Barré syndrome.

### Laparotomy

A misspelling of laparotomy, an operation involving incision through the abdominal wall to enter the

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abdominal cavity.

### **Laryngismus Stridulus**

An older term for brief laryngeal spasm causing inspiratory stridor, historically associated with childhood spasmodic croup or tetany.

### **Latissimus Dorsi**

A broad back muscle that extends and internally rotates the arm and assists movements such as climbing.

### **Lats**

An informal abbreviation for the latissimus dorsi muscles.

### **Learning Difficulties**

Persistent problems acquiring or using academic skills such as reading, writing, or mathematics, not explained solely by low intelligence or inadequate education.

### **Leech**

A blood-feeding annelid used in selected reconstructive procedures to relieve venous congestion; leech bites can cause bleeding and infection.

### **Legg-Calvé-Perthes Disease**

A childhood disorder caused by temporary loss of blood supply to the femoral head, resulting in avascular necrosis and hip pain or limp.

### **Lemaitre's Sign**

Pain or discomfort in the urethra or penis during digital rectal examination, traditionally associated with posterior urethral or prostatic inflammation.

### **Lengthening Of Limb**

A surgical or orthopedic process that gradually increases the length of a bone, often using controlled distraction after osteotomy.

### **Lethal**

Capable of causing death.

### **Let-Down Reflex**

Release of milk from the breast when oxytocin causes contraction of myoepithelial cells around mammary alveoli.

### **Leucocyte**

A white blood cell involved in immune defense.

### **Leucocytosis**

An abnormally increased number of white blood cells in the blood.

### **Leucoderma**

Loss or marked reduction of skin pigmentation, often used as a descriptive term for depigmented patches.

### **Leucomalacia**

Softening of tissue caused by injury, classically white-matter injury in periventricular leukomalacia.

### **Leucoplakia**

A persistent white mucosal patch that cannot be scraped off and may require assessment for dysplasia or cancer risk.

### **Leucopoiesis**

The production and maturation of white blood cells.

### **Leukaemia**

Cancer of blood-forming tissues in which abnormal leukocytes proliferate and disrupt normal marrow function.

### **Levomepromazine**

A phenothiazine medicine with antipsychotic, sedative, antiemetic, and analgesic properties, used in selected palliative-care and psychiatric settings.

### **Levulose**

An older name for fructose, a simple sugar found in fruit, honey, and many sweeteners.

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### **Leydig Cells**

Testicular interstitial cells that produce testosterone in response to luteinizing hormone.

### **LieberküHn's Crypts**

Tubular intestinal glands between the villi that contain absorptive, secretory, and stem cells.

### **Lieno-**

A combining form meaning relating to the spleen.

### **Light**

Visible electromagnetic radiation; in medicine it is used for examination, phototherapy, imaging, and selected treatments.

### **Light Reflex**

Constriction of the pupil in response to light, mediated by the retinal, optic, midbrain, and oculomotor pathways.

### **Lightning Pains**

Brief, stabbing, electric-shock-like pains, classically occurring in tabes dorsalis or other nerve disorders.

### **Lignocaine**

The international nonproprietary name for lidocaine, a local anesthetic and antiarrhythmic drug.

### **Limbic Lobe**

A curved group of cortical structures on the medial cerebral hemisphere involved in emotion, memory, and motivation.

### **Limbs**

The arms and legs, including their bones, joints, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

### **Linea**

A line or linear anatomical marking, often used in names such as linea alba or linea nigra.

### **Linear Accelerator**

A device that accelerates electrons to produce high-

energy X-rays or electron beams for radiotherapy.

### **Linear Fracture**

A narrow crack in a bone without significant displacement or fragmentation.

### **Lingua**

The tongue.

### **Lipidosis**

A disorder involving abnormal accumulation or metabolism of lipids in tissues, often due to inherited enzyme defects.

### **Lipo-**

A combining form meaning relating to fat or lipids.

### **Lipocaic**

A historical term for a pancreatic substance once thought to regulate fat metabolism; it is not a current standard clinical diagnosis.

### **Lipochrome**

A fat-soluble pigment, such as a carotenoid or lipofuscin-related pigment, that can impart yellow coloration to tissues.

### **Lipocyte**

A fat cell, also called an adipocyte.

### **Lipschütz Bodies**

An older term for nonspecific acute genital ulcers, often occurring in adolescents or young women after an infection.

### **Liquefaction**

Conversion of a solid or semisolid material into a liquid, as in liquefactive necrosis.

### **Liquor**

A liquid; in clinical usage it may refer to cerebrospinal fluid or a medicinal preparation, depending on context.

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### **Lithotomy**

A surgical procedure for removing a stone, or the position with the hips and knees flexed and legs supported.

### **Lithotripter**

A device that fragments urinary or other calculi using shock waves or endoscopic energy.

### **Litmus**

A dye that changes color with acidity or alkalinity and is used as a simple pH indicator.

### **Liver, Diseases Of**

Disorders of the liver, including hepatitis, fatty liver, cirrhosis, tumors, and biliary disease, that can impair metabolism and detoxification.

### **Liver Fluke**

A parasitic flatworm that infects the liver or bile ducts, including *Clonorchis*, *Opisthorchis*, and *Fasciola* species.

### **Liver Function Tests (LFTs)**

Blood tests assessing liver-cell injury, bile flow, and synthetic function, commonly including aminotransferases, alkaline phosphatase, bilirubin, albumin, and clotting measures.

### **Liver Spot**

A common lay term for a solar lentigo, a flat brown skin patch caused by chronic ultraviolet exposure.

### **Local Anaesthesia**

Loss of sensation in a limited body area caused by a local anesthetic without loss of consciousness.

### **Localization**

Determining the anatomical site responsible for a symptom, sign, lesion, or physiological function.

### **Locomotor Ataxia**

An older term for tabes dorsalis, a neurologic complication of untreated syphilis causing sensory ataxia and lightning pains.

### **Loin**

The region of the lower back between the ribs and pelvis, including the flank.

### **Long-Sightedness**

Hyperopia, a refractive error in which distant objects may be clearer than near objects and accommodation is required for focusing.

### **Loop Diuretic**

A diuretic that inhibits sodium and chloride reabsorption in the thick ascending loop of Henle, producing powerful natriuresis.

### **Loose Bodies**

Free fragments of cartilage, bone, or other tissue within a joint or body cavity that may cause pain, catching, or locking.

### **Low-Density Lipoprotein (LDL)**

A cholesterol-carrying lipoprotein; persistently elevated LDL cholesterol contributes to atherosclerotic cardiovascular risk.

### **Low-Incision**

A low or small surgical incision; the precise meaning depends on the procedure and anatomical site.

### **Lozenges**

Solid medicinal preparations that dissolve slowly in the mouth, usually to provide local treatment for the throat or oral cavity.

### **Lucilia**

A genus of blowflies; some species can cause wound myiasis, while sterile larvae have occasionally been used in maggot debridement.

### **Lugol's Iodine**

An aqueous solution of iodine and potassium iodide used as an antiseptic, in selected thyroid treatments, and in some laboratory procedures.

### **Lumbricals**

Small hand or foot muscles arising from tendons of

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the flexor digitorum profundus or flexor digitorum longus and assisting flexion-extension coordination.

### **Luminescent**

Emitting visible light without being incandescent, as in some diagnostic markers or biological phenomena.

### **Lumpy Jaw**

A chronic granulomatous infection of the jaw, usually cervicofacial actinomycosis, causing swelling and sinus formation.

### **Lunar Caustic**

An old name for silver nitrate, a caustic agent formerly used to cauterize tissue and treat some lesions.

### **Lung, Diseases Of**

Conditions affecting the airways, alveoli, pleura, or pulmonary circulation, including infection, asthma, COPD, fibrosis, and cancer.

### **Lung Fluke**

A parasitic trematode, especially *Paragonimus* species, whose infection can cause chronic cough, hemoptysis, and pulmonary lesions.

### **Lunula**

The pale crescent-shaped area at the base of a fingernail or toenail.

### **Luteinizing Hormone (LH)**

A pituitary gonadotropin that triggers ovulation and corpus-luteum formation and stimulates testosterone production in the testes.

### **Luteinizing Hormone-Releasing Hormone (LHRH)**

Another name for gonadotropin-releasing hormone, which stimulates pituitary release of LH and FSH.

### **Luteotropic Hormone**

A hormone that supports the corpus luteum; the term traditionally refers mainly to prolactin, although usage varies by species and source.

### **Lutetic**

Relating to the corpus luteum or its function.

### **Lymphoedema**

A misspelling of lymphoedema, swelling caused by accumulation of protein-rich lymph when lymphatic drainage is impaired.

### **Lymphogranuloma Inguinale**

An older name for lymphogranuloma venereum, a sexually transmitted infection caused by invasive *Chlamydia trachomatis* serovars.

### **Lymphoid Tissue**

Tissue containing lymphocytes and supporting immune responses, found in lymph nodes, spleen, thymus, tonsils, and mucosal sites.

### **Lymphoedema**

Chronic swelling caused by impaired lymphatic drainage, most often affecting a limb but potentially involving other regions.

### **Lyonnaise**

A historical term associated with a Lyon-based medical classification or method; its precise meaning depends on the source and should be verified.

### **Lysol**

A historical trade name for cresol-containing disinfectant preparations; products and formulations vary, and ingestion or concentrated exposure is hazardous.

### **Lysozyme**

An antimicrobial enzyme that cleaves bacterial cell-wall peptidoglycan and is found in tears, saliva, breast milk, and some leukocytes.

### **Lyssa**

Rabies, a fatal viral infection of the central nervous system transmitted most often through saliva from an infected animal.

### **Synonyms:**

Compact bone

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## Lamina

A thin plate of bone forming part of a vertebral arch.

## Laser Assisted Uvula Palatoplasty

A procedure that reshapes or removes selected soft-palate and uvula tissue to reduce snoring.

### Synonyms:

LAUP

## Laser Hair Removal

Hair reduction using laser energy absorbed by pigment in the hair follicle.

## LED Photomodulation

Use of low-energy light-emitting diodes to influence skin cells and improve selected skin concerns.

### Synonyms:

LED light therapy

## Left Anterior Descending Coronary Artery

A major coronary artery supplying the front wall and septum of the left ventricle.

### Synonyms:

LAD artery

## Left Circumflex Coronary Artery

A coronary artery that curves around the left side and back of the heart.

### Synonyms:

Circumflex artery

## Lensometer

An instrument used to measure the prescription and optical properties of eyeglass lenses.

### Synonyms:

Lensmeter; focimeter

## Leukotriene Blockers

Medicines that reduce leukotriene effects and help prevent asthma or allergy symptoms.

### Synonyms:

Leukotriene antagonists

## Leukotrienes

Inflammatory signaling molecules that can narrow and swell airways during allergic reactions.

## Levothyroxine Sodium

The sodium salt of synthetic thyroxine used to replace deficient thyroid hormone.

### Synonyms:

Levothyroxine

## LH

Luteinizing hormone, a pituitary hormone involved in ovulation and testosterone production.

### Synonyms:

Luteinizing hormone

## Lignans

Plant compounds found in seeds, grains, fruits, and vegetables that have antioxidant activity.

## Limbus

The border where the cornea meets the white outer coat of the eye.

### Synonyms:

Corneoscleral limbus

## Lipids

Fats, oils, and related substances used for energy, cell structure, and signaling.

## Lip Swelling

Enlargement of one or both lips caused by local injury, infection, inflammation, dental disease, medication, or angioedema. Sudden swelling of the lips with tongue or throat swelling, breathing difficulty, wheezing, faintness, or widespread hives may indicate a severe allergic reaction and requires emergency care.

### Synonyms:

Fats

## Lipohypertrophy

Localized thickening or accumulation of fatty tissue, commonly at repeated insulin-injection sites.



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### **Lipoprotein Analysis**

A blood test measuring cholesterol, triglycerides, and lipoprotein fractions such as LDL and HDL.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lipid panel; lipid profile

### **Lipoprotein(A)**

An LDL-like lipoprotein whose elevated level is an inherited cardiovascular risk factor.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lp(a)

### **Liposuction**

Liposuction examines liposuction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lipoplasty

### **Live Attenuated Vaccines**

Vaccines containing weakened organisms that stimulate immunity without usually causing disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Live vaccines

### **Living Donor**

Individual who donates an organ (kidney, liver segment, or other tissue) while alive for transplantation into a recipient.

### **Lobar Hemorrhage**

Bleeding into a lobe of the brain, beneath the cerebral cortex.

### **Lobotomy**

A historical brain operation that severed connections involving the frontal lobes.

### **Lobules**

Small subdivisions of an organ; in the breast, milk-producing glandular units.

### **Localized**

Limited to a particular area or organ, without evi-

dence of distant spread.

#### **Synonyms:**

Localized disease

### **Locus Ceruleus**

A brainstem nucleus involved in alertness, attention, stress responses, and norepinephrine release.

#### **Synonyms:**

Locus coeruleus

### **Long-Term Memory**

Memory that can persist from minutes to many years.

### **Low-Calorie Diet**

A diet that restricts energy intake to support weight loss or another therapeutic goal.

#### **Synonyms:**

Calorie-restricted diet

### **Low-Density Lipoprotein**

A lipoprotein that transports cholesterol and can contribute to artery-wall plaque when elevated.

#### **Synonyms:**

LDL; bad cholesterol

### **Lower Esophageal Sphincter**

A ring of muscle between the esophagus and stomach that helps prevent acid reflux.

#### **Synonyms:**

LES

### **Lumbar Spine**

The five vertebrae forming the lower back.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lumbar region

### **Lutein**

A carotenoid pigment found in leafy greens and concentrated in the retina.

### **Luteinizing Hormone-Releasing Hormone Agonist**

A medicine that initially stimulates and then sup-

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presses reproductive-hormone production with continued use.

**Synonyms:**

GnRH agonist; LHRH agonist

**LVAD**

Left-ventricular assist device, an implanted pump that helps the left ventricle circulate blood.

**Synonyms:**

Left-ventricular assist device

**Lymph Nodes**

Small immune organs that filter lymph and help detect infection or abnormal cells.

**Synonyms:**

Lymph glands

**Labor Dystocia**

Abnormally slow or difficult labor caused by inadequate uterine forces, abnormal fetal position or size, or an inadequate maternal pelvis. Assessment considers the powers, passenger, and passage and guides appropriate augmentation or operative delivery.

**Laboratory Test**

An examination of a body fluid, tissue, or other specimen to obtain information for diagnosis, monitoring, screening, or treatment.

**Labour**

The process of childbirth, consisting of regular uterine contractions that cause progressive cervical effacement and dilation, leading to delivery of the baby and placenta.

**Labyrinth**

The inner ear. It contains the cochlea, which is responsible for hearing, as well as structures that are needed for balance.

**Labyrinthitis**

Labyrinthitis is inflammation of the inner ear balance and hearing structures, causing acute vertigo, imbalance, nausea, and sometimes hearing loss. vestibular apparatus, resulting in both au-

ditory and vestibular symptoms including sudden, severe vertigo, sensorineural hearing loss, tinnitus, nausea, and vomiting.

**Laceration**

A wound caused by tearing of body tissue, typically caused by trauma from a sharp object (knife, glass, metal) or blunt force that splits the skin. Lacerations involve the skin and may extend into subcutaneous tissue, muscle, tendon, nerve, or blood vessels.

**Laceration (Forensic)**

Tear or disruption of tissue produced by blunt force trauma exceeding skin elasticity, featuring irregular bruised edges, tissue bridging (intact nerves, vessels across wound floor), and hair crushing.

**Synonyms:**

Forensic

**Lachman Test**

A physical examination in which the knee is slightly flexed while the tibia is moved forward to assess the integrity of the anterior cruciate ligament. Increased laxity suggests injury but is not diagnostic by itself.

**Lacrimal Apparatus**

Produces, distributes, and drains tears for corneal moisture and protection. Components: lacrimal gland (superolateral orbit, parasympathetic CN V1, produces aqueous tear layer), superior/inferior puncta (medial eyelid openings), canaliculi, lacrimal sac (lacrimal groove), and nasolacrimal duct (drains into inferior meatus).

**Lacrimal Duct**

A drainage channel that carries tears from the lacrimal sac into the nasal cavity. Blockage can cause watering of the eye, recurrent infection, swelling near the inner corner, or discharge.

**Lacrimal Gland**

The paired almond-shaped exocrine glands that secrete the aqueous layer of the tear film, located in the lacrimal fossa of the superior lateral orbit (orbital part) and the upper eyelid (palpebral part).

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## Lactate

A product of cellular metabolism measured in blood. An increased level may occur with strenuous exercise, impaired oxygen delivery, infection, medicines, liver disease, or other conditions and must be interpreted clinically.

## Lactate Dehydrogenase

Non-specific enzyme. Elevated in tissue damage. Isoenzymes differentiate source.

## Lactation

The physiological process of milk production and secretion from the mammary glands, occurring after childbirth (puerperium). See Lactation (Breastfeeding).

## Lactation (Breastfeeding)

The production of milk by the mammary glands stimulated by the hormone prolactin. Colostrum is produced for the first 2-5 days (rich in IgA, proteins, and growth factors). Mature milk appears at day 5-7. The milk ejection reflex (let-down) is mediated by oxytocin.

### Synonyms:

Breastfeeding

## Lactation Nutrition

Nutrition and hydration during breastfeeding sufficient to support maternal health and milk production. Requirements vary with maternal stores, dietary pattern, and the degree of breastfeeding; selected supplements may be required according to local guidance and clinical assessment.

## Lactic Acid

An organic acid produced during normal metabolism, especially when pyruvate is converted to lactate. Blood lactate may rise for many reasons, including impaired oxygen delivery, strenuous exercise, or medicines.

## Lactic Acidosis

Metabolic acidosis associated with increased lactate production or reduced lactate clearance. Causes

include impaired tissue oxygen delivery, medicines, liver disease, seizures, and other disorders.

## Lactose

The principal sugar in milk, composed of glucose and galactose. Lactase in the small intestine digests it.

## Lactose Fermentation

The ability of bacteria to ferment lactose to acid (and gas), a key differential characteristic on MacConkey agar. Lactose-fermenting enteric gram-negative bacteria produce pink/red colonies (*E. coli*, *Klebsiella*, *Enterobacter*, *Citrobacter*); non-lactose fermenters form colorless colonies (*Salmonella*, *Shigella*, *Proteus*, *Pseudomonas*).

## Lactose Intolerance

Lactose intolerance results from insufficient lactase activity, causing bloating, abdominal pain, gas, or diarrhea after consuming lactose. Lactose, the primary disaccharide in milk and dairy products. The lactase enzyme is produced by enterocytes of the small intestinal brush border and hydrolyzes lactose into glucose and galactose for absorption.

### Synonyms:

Lactase Deficiency Milk Intolerance Milk Intolerance (Lactose Intolerance)

## Lactose Tolerance Test

Non-invasive test for carbohydrate malabsorption (lactose, fructose) and small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO). See Hydrogen Breath Test.

## Lafora Disease

A progressive autosomal-recessive myoclonic epilepsy caused by pathogenic variants affecting glycogen metabolism. It usually begins in adolescence with generalized seizures, visual symptoms, myoclonus, cognitive decline, and progressive neurological deterioration.

## Lambert-Eaton Myasthenic Syndrome

Autoantibodies against presynaptic calcium channels at the neuromuscular junction, associated with SCLC. Proximal weakness, reduced reflexes, faci-

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tation with exercise.

### **Laminectomy**

Laminectomy removes part of a vertebral lamina to decompress the spinal canal or nerve roots, often for stenosis, tumor, or selected disk disease. Indications: spinal stenosis (lumbar and cervical), herniated disc (with central stenosis), and spinal tumor. Decompression of the entire spinal canal. Often combined with discectomy (lumbar) or foraminotomy (nerve root decompression).

### **Lancet**

Small needle for fingerstick. Used for blood glucose testing.

### **Langerhans-Cell Histiocytosis**

A group of disorders characterized by clonal proliferation of Langerhans cells (antigen-presenting dendritic cells), which can infiltrate bone, skin, and central nervous system. CNS involvement may cause diabetes insipidus, hypothalamic-pituitary dysfunction, or cerebellar degeneration.

### **Language Barrier**

Difficulty communicating because a patient and healthcare professional do not share a language or have limited proficiency in the language used for care.

### **Language Therapy**

Treatment that improves understanding, expression, reading, writing, or other language skills after developmental or acquired impairment.

### **Lanugo**

Fine, soft hair that grows all over the body of a fetus and is typically shed before birth.

### **Laparoscopy**

A minimally invasive surgical technique using a laparoscope (a thin, lighted telescope) inserted through a small incision (typically at the umbilicus) to visualize the abdominal and pelvic organs. Carbon dioxide gas is insufflated to create a work-

ing space. Additional small incisions (ports) allow insertion of instruments.

### **Laparotomy**

A surgical incision into the abdominal cavity, typically a midline vertical or transverse (Pfannenstiel) incision, providing wide access to the abdominal and pelvic organs.

### **Large Airway Obstruction**

Obstruction of airways with diameter > 2 mm (trachea and main bronchi). It causes significant symptoms including stridor, dyspnea, and impaired secretion clearance. It may be fixed (stenosis, tumor) or variable (tracheomalacia, vocal cord dysfunction). Flow-volume loops show characteristic patterns.

### **Large Bowel Obstruction**

Mechanical blockage of the colon most commonly caused by colorectal cancer, volvulus, or diverticular stricture. Clinical presentation includes progressive abdominal distension, constipation, and obstipation. The cecum is at highest risk of perforation with distal obstruction. Diagnosis is by CT scan identifying the site and cause.

### **Large For Gestational Age**

Birth weight or fetal size above the 90th percentile for gestational age. It is associated with maternal diabetes, excessive maternal weight gain, and genetic or constitutional factors and increases the risk of shoulder dystocia, birth trauma, and neonatal hypoglycemia.

### **Large Intestine**

Final GI segment (approximately 1.5 meters) from ileocecal valve to rectum. Six segments: cecum, ascending, transverse, descending, sigmoid colon, rectum. Absorbs water, electrolytes, and vitamins (K, biotin) from colonic bacteria. Characterized by haustra, taenia coli, and epiploic appendages.

### **Laron Syndrome**

An inherited disorder of growth-hormone signaling, usually caused by growth-hormone-receptor defects. It produces severe postnatal growth failure, char-

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acteristic facial features, and very low insulin-like growth factor 1 despite elevated circulating growth hormone.

### **Larva Currens From Strongyloides**

A rapidly moving, itchy skin eruption caused by larvae of *Strongyloides stercoralis*.

### **Laryngeal Cancer**

Malignant tumor arising in the larynx, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma. Risk factors include tobacco, alcohol, and selected HPV-related disease; persistent hoarseness, dysphagia, odynophagia, stridor, or neck mass requires laryngoscopic evaluation and biopsy.

### **Laryngeal Candidiasis**

Fungal infection of the larynx by *Candida* species, causing hoarseness, dysphagia, and throat pain, most commonly in immunocompromised patients or those using inhaled corticosteroids.

### **Laryngeal Nerve Damage**

Injury to the recurrent or superior laryngeal nerves causing hoarseness, vocal-cord weakness, swallowing difficulty, or airway compromise. Common causes include thyroid or neck surgery, malignancy, trauma, and compression along the nerve pathway.

### **Laryngeal Prosthesis**

A device used to help restore speech after removal of the larynx, commonly through a one-way valve placed between the trachea and esophagus.

### **Laryngectomy**

Laryngectomy examines laryngectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. the larynx or hypopharynx and less often for severe trauma or refractory aspiration. Total laryngectomy requires a permanent tracheostomy, so the patient breathes through a neck stoma; partial laryngectomy preserves voice and swallowing.

### **Laryngectomy Tube**

Tube maintaining airway after total laryngectomy. Types: silicone, metal. Indications: laryngeal cancer, trauma. Complications: obstruction, infection, granulation.

### **Laryngitis**

Laryngitis is inflammation of the larynx causing hoarseness or voice loss, commonly from viral infection, vocal overuse, irritation, reflux, or less often structural disease. sore throat, dry cough, and a sensation of a lump in the throat (globus sensation), and it may be acute or chronic.

### **Laryngocele**

Abnormal air-filled dilation of the laryngeal saccule that may be internal, external, or combined, presenting with hoarseness, neck swelling, or airway obstruction.

### **Laryngomalacia**

Dynamic collapse of supraglottic laryngeal tissue during inspiration, causing congenital stridor in infants. Most cases improve with growth, but feeding difficulty, apnea, hypoxemia, or failure to thrive requires specialist assessment and possible intervention.

### **Laryngopharyngeal Reflux**

Retrograde movement of gastric contents above the upper esophageal sphincter into the larynx and pharynx, producing chronic hoarseness, throat clearing, globus sensation, cough, excessive throat mucus, and laryngospasm, often without heartburn.

### **Laryngoscope**

Device for visualizing vocal cords during intubation. Blades: Mac (curved), Miller (straight).

### **Laryngoscopy**

A medical procedure used to visualise the larynx (voice box) and adjacent structures of the throat. Types: (1) Indirect laryngoscopy: the simplest technique, using a laryngeal mirror angled at 120 degrees to reflect the laryngeal image, with a headlight or external light source.

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## Laryngospasm

A protective reflex causing involuntary adduction of the vocal cords, producing partial or complete airway obstruction. It is common during light anesthesia, emergence, and in pediatric patients. Triggers include secretions, blood, airway manipulation, and suctioning.

## Larynx

The larynx, commonly known as the voice box, is a complex organ located in the anterior neck between the pharynx and the trachea that serves three primary functions: phonation (voice production), protection of the lower airway from aspiration during swallowing, and regulation of airflow during respiration.

## Laser (Vascular)

A catheter-based laser system used to modify or remove selected vascular lesions or obstructive tissue.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Laser Ablation

The use of focused laser energy to heat, destroy, or seal targeted tissue. The technique is used in selected vascular, ophthalmic, dermatologic, and other procedures.

## Laser Dentistry

Use of lasers for various procedures: caries detection, soft tissue surgery, whitening, periodontal therapy.

## Laser Fiber

Optical fiber for laser delivery in surgery. Used in lithotripsy, tumor ablation.

## Laser Trabeculoplasty

A minimally invasive laser procedure used in the treatment of open-angle glaucoma that lowers intraocular pressure by improving the outflow of aqueous humor through the trabecular meshwork.

## LASIK

LASIK, or laser-assisted in situ keratomileusis, is

a refractive surgical procedure that corrects myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism by reshaping the corneal stroma using an excimer laser, after creating a thin corneal flap with either a microkeratome (a mechanical blade) or a femtosecond laser.

## LASIK (Laser-Assisted In Situ Keratomileusis)

A refractive surgical procedure that reshapes the cornea using an excimer laser to correct myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism, thereby reducing dependence on glasses or contact lenses.

### Synonyms:

Laser-Assisted In Situ Keratomileusis

## Lassa Fever

An acute viral hemorrhagic illness caused by Lassa virus, an arenavirus, endemic in West Africa (Nigeria, Sierra Leone, Guinea, Liberia). Transmission: exposure to excreta (urine, feces) of the multimammate rat (*Mastomys natalensis*), the natural reservoir. Incubation: 6-21 days.

## Last Menstrual Period

The first day of the last normal menstrual period, used to estimate gestational age and the due date. Requires regular menstrual cycles and reliable recall. Limitations: irregular cycles, recent oral contraceptive use, early pregnancy bleeding mistaken for menses, and poor recall.

## Latarjet Procedure

Surgical procedure for shoulder instability using coracoid process transfer. Provides bony block to prevent recurrent dislocation.

## Late Decelerations

A fetal heart rate pattern with a gradual decrease (onset to nadir >30 seconds) that starts at or after the peak of the contraction and returns to baseline after the contraction ends. Associated with uteroplacental insufficiency (reduced oxygen transfer across the placenta).

## Late Effects

Health problems occurring months to years after



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cancer treatment. Cardiac, pulmonary, endocrine, secondary cancers.

### **Late Preterm (34-36 Weeks)**

Births occurring from 34 weeks 0 days through 36 weeks 6 days of gestation. These infants have greater risks than term infants of respiratory, temperature, glucose, jaundice, feeding, and readmission problems.

#### **Synonyms:**

34-36 weeks

### **Latent Infection**

Persistent infection in which an infectious agent remains in a host in a nonreplicating or intermittently replicating state without active clinical disease. Reactivation can occur when immune control is impaired, as in latent tuberculosis.

### **Latent Phase Of Labor**

The early part of the first stage of labor, beginning with regular contractions and gradual cervical change before active labor. The transition to active labor is assessed clinically, and the duration varies widely between individuals.

### **Latent Tuberculosis Infection**

An immune response to *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* without clinical or microbiologic evidence of active disease. It is usually asymptomatic and not contagious, but it can reactivate; treatment decisions depend on age, immune status, exposure risk, test results, and drug interactions.

### **Lateral**

Lateral means toward or situated on the side away from the body's midline; it contrasts with medial and is used to describe anatomical position, movement, or imaging findings. lateral to the little finger in anatomical position.

### **Lateral Collateral Ligament Injury**

Tear of the LCL, less common than MCL injury but more significant. Mechanism: varus stress to the knee (direct blow to medial knee). Presents with lateral knee pain, swelling, and varus laxity. Part

of the posterolateral corner (PLC) — when injured, causes significant rotational instability.

### **Lateral Cuneiform**

Located between intermediate cuneiform and cuboid, articulating with navicular, intermediate cuneiform, cuboid, and third metatarsal. Contributes to the transverse arch and lateral foot column. Injuries typically from high-energy midfoot trauma.

### **Lateral Rotation**

Rotation of a limb away from the median plane of the body.

### **Latex Allergy**

An immune-mediated hypersensitivity reaction to natural rubber latex. Contact may cause dermatitis, urticaria, rhinitis, asthma, or anaphylaxis, especially in healthcare and occupational settings.

#### **Synonyms:**

Allergy Latex (Latex Allergy)

### **Latissimus Dorsi Muscle**

Broadest back muscle forming the posterior axillary wall, from T7-L5 spinous processes, thoracolumbar fascia, iliac crest, and lower ribs to the intertubercular groove floor. Innervated by thoracodorsal nerve (C6-C8). Adducts, medially rotates, extends the arm powerfully in swimming/rowing/climbing. Common reconstructive surgery flap.

### **Lawton IADL Scale**

Instrumental ADLs: phone use, shopping, food preparation, housekeeping, laundry, transportation, medication management, finance management.

### **Laxative**

A drug that promotes bowel evacuation, used for constipation and bowel preparation. Classes: bulk-forming (psyllium, methylcellulose), osmotic (polyethylene glycol, lactulose, magnesium salts), stimulant (senna, bisacodyl), stool softener (docusate), and lubricant (mineral oil). Choice depends on constipation type and patient factors.

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## **LD50**

Lethal dose for 50% of test population. Measure of acute toxicity. Lower LD50 = more toxic. Measured in mg/kg body weight. Ethical concerns limit animal testing.

## **LDL**

Low-density lipoprotein; the 'bad' cholesterol that transports cholesterol to peripheral tissues and is the principal driver of atherosclerosis. Elevated LDL is a major modifiable cardiovascular risk factor; guidelines target LDL levels based on global risk (statin intensity).

## **Lead Poisoning**

Neurotoxic, hematological, renal effects. Sources: paint, water, gasoline, occupational. Children more vulnerable. Treatment: chelation (succimer, EDTA, dimercaprol), remove exposure. Blood lead level guides treatment.

## **Lead-Time Bias**

The appearance of improved survival after screening because diagnosis occurs earlier, even when the time of death is unchanged. It can make screening appear beneficial without reducing mortality.

## **Leber Congenital Amaurosis**

The most severe inherited retinal dystrophy, presenting at birth or within the first few months of life with profound visual impairment, nystagmus, and pupillary light-near dissociation.

## **Left Anterior Descending Artery**

A major branch of the left coronary artery that travels in the anterior interventricular groove and supplies the anterior left ventricle, much of the interventricular septum, and the apex. Its occlusion can cause extensive anterior myocardial infarction.

## **Left Atrial Myxoma**

A usually benign primary cardiac tumor, commonly arising from the interatrial septum in the left atrium. It may obstruct mitral inflow or cause embolic and constitutional symptoms such as fever, weight loss, or fatigue.

## **Left Atrium**

Receives oxygenated blood from 4 pulmonary veins. Most posterior chamber forming the cardiac base on chest radiography. Smooth walls from absorbed pulmonary veins; small auricle with pectinate muscles. Mitral valve separates it from the left ventricle.

## **Left Bundle Branch**

A continuation of the bundle of His that divides into anterior and posterior fascicles. The anterior fascicle supplies the anterior and superior left ventricular wall; the posterior fascicle supplies the inferior and posterior wall.

## **Left Hemiparesis, Gaze Deviated To The Right**

A clinical finding indicating a right hemisphere lesion, likely a right middle cerebral artery stroke. Gaze deviation toward the right suggests the lesion is in the right frontal eye field, which normally drives gaze to the contralateral (left) side; when damaged, the intact left frontal eye field drives gaze ipsilaterally (to the right).

## **Left Hypochondriac Region**

Upper left abdomen lateral to the epigastric region, containing the spleen, stomach fundus, splenic flexure, and pancreatic tail. Important for evaluating splenomegaly, gastric pathology, and splenic infarction. The spleen is normally not palpable below the costal margin; enlargement into this region is a significant finding.

## **Left Iliac Region**

Lower left abdomen containing the descending colon, sigmoid colon, and left ureter. Important for evaluating diverticulosis and diverticulitis, most commonly affecting the sigmoid colon here. Palpation may reveal masses from inflammatory bowel disease or colorectal cancer.

## **Left Main Coronary Artery**

The short vessel arising from the left aortic sinus and dividing principally into the left anterior descending and circumflex arteries. Significant left-main disease jeopardizes a large proportion of left-ventricular

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myocardium.

### **Left Testicular Torsion**

Acute rotation of the left testis on its spermatic cord, obstructing blood flow and causing ischemia. It is a urological emergency presenting with sudden severe left scrotal pain, nausea, vomiting, and a high-riding, horizontally oriented testis with absent cremasteric reflex.

### **Left Ventricle**

Thickest cardiac chamber (13-15 mm), pumping oxygenated blood into the aorta for systemic distribution. Generates approximately 120 mmHg systolic pressure. Receives blood through the mitral valve; ejects through the aortic valve.

### **Left Ventricular Noncompaction**

A rare cardiomyopathy characterized by prominent myocardial trabeculations with deep intertrabecular recesses, thought to result from arrested myocardial compaction during embryogenesis. It may present with heart failure, arrhythmias, or thromboembolism.

### **Left-Sided Superior Vena Cava**

A congenital venous anomaly where the left superior vena cava drains into the coronary sinus instead of the right atrium via the right SVC. It is the most common thoracic venous anomaly, present in 0.3–0.5% of the general population. Usually asymptomatic but relevant during central venous catheterization or cardiac surgery.

### **Leg Ulcer**

An open sore on the leg that fails to heal normally, often caused by poor venous circulation, arterial disease, diabetes, pressure, or inflammation. Pain, spreading redness, fever, or black tissue requires prompt assessment.

### **Legg-Calvé-Perthes Disease**

Idiopathic avascular necrosis of the femoral head in children, typically ages 4-8 years. More common in boys (4:1) and Caucasian children. Presents with limping (antalgic gait), hip/knee pain, and limited

hip range of motion (especially abduction and internal rotation). Etiology: temporary disruption of blood supply to the femoral head.

### **Legg-Calvé-Perthes Disease**

Idiopathic avascular necrosis of the femoral head in children, typically between ages two and twelve, resulting from disrupted blood supply to the capital femoral epiphysis. It presents with insidious onset of hip pain, limp, and restricted range of motion.

### **Legionella Pneumonia**

From *Legionella pneumophila* in water systems. Presents with high fever, diarrhea, confusion, and hyponatremia. Diagnosis by urinary antigen test. Treatment is fluoroquinolones or macrolides.

### **Legionella Pneumophila**

A gram-negative rod that causes Legionnaires' disease, a severe pneumonia, and Pontiac fever, a milder illness. The organism is found in aquatic environments and is transmitted through inhalation of contaminated water droplets. Risk factors include age, smoking, and immunosuppression.

### **Legionnaires' Disease**

A severe form of pneumonia caused by *Legionella pneumophila*, a Gram-negative aerobic bacillus that is found naturally in freshwater environments (lakes, streams) and artificially in water systems (air conditioning cooling towers, hot tubs, decorative fountains, plumbing systems, showers, humidifiers).

### **Leiomyoma**

Uterine fibroid: a benign smooth muscle tumor of the uterus (estrogen/progesterone-sensitive), the most common pelvic tumor in women. Locations: subserosal, intramural, submucosal (most symptomatic).

### **Leiomyoma (Fibroid)**

A benign tumor of uterine smooth muscle that may cause heavy menstrual bleeding, pelvic pressure, pain, or no symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Fibroid

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## Leiomyosarcoma

A malignant tumor of smooth muscle, most often arising in the uterus, retroperitoneum, or gastrointestinal tract.

## Leishmania Donovanii

A protozoan parasite that causes visceral leishmaniasis (kala-azar), transmitted by the bite of infected female phlebotomine sandflies. The organism exists as flagellated promastigotes in the sandfly gut and as non-flagellated amastigotes within human macrophages.

## Leishmaniasis

Leishmaniasis is infection by *Leishmania* parasites transmitted by sandflies, producing cutaneous, mucosal, or visceral disease depending on species and host response. of infected female phlebotomine sandflies. Visceral leishmaniasis (kala-azar): caused by *L. donovani*/*L. infantum* – fever, hepatosplenomegaly, pancytopenia, weight loss, hypergammaglobulinaemia; fatal if untreated.

## Length-Time Bias

The tendency of screening to preferentially detect slower-growing or less aggressive disease because it remains detectable for a longer preclinical period. It can exaggerate the apparent benefit of screening.

## Lens

Transparent biconvex avascular structure behind the iris/pupil, suspended by zonular fibers from the ciliary body. Provides approximately one-third of refractive power and allows accommodation (focusing on near objects by changing shape). Concentric lens fiber layers from surface epithelium, surrounded by a capsule.

## Lentigo Maligna

A melanoma in situ that occurs on chronically sun-damaged skin, most commonly on the face of elderly individuals. It presents as a large, irregularly pigmented, slow-growing macule with variegated shades of brown and black. The radial growth phase may persist for years before invasion occurs.

## Leopold Maneuvers

A systematic abdominal palpation technique used to determine fetal position and presentation. Four maneuvers: (1) fundal grip identifies fetal lie (head vs breech), (2) umbilical grip locates the fetal back, (3) Pawlik grip identifies the presenting part and its position, (4) pelvic grip confirms presentation and attitude.

## Lepromatous Leprosy

The disseminated, multibacillary pole of the leprosy spectrum characterised by poor cell-mediated immunity to *Mycobacterium leprae*, resulting in widespread skin nodules, plaques, and diffuse infiltration with thickening of the skin and facial features (leonine facies).

## Leprosy

A chronic infection caused by *Mycobacterium leprae* or *M. lepromatosis* that primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves. It can cause numb or discolored skin patches, loss of sensation, nerve thickening, weakness, eye injury, and deformity; untreated disease may also affect the nose and other organs. Transmission usually requires prolonged close contact, and multidrug antibiotic therapy can cure the infection and prevent disability.

## Leprosy (Hansen's Disease)

Another name for leprosy, a chronic infection caused by *Mycobacterium leprae* or *M. lepromatosis* that primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves. It can cause numb skin lesions, sensory loss, nerve damage, weakness, eye injury, and deformity; early multidrug antibiotic therapy limits transmission and prevents disability.

### Synonyms:

Hansen's Disease

## Leptin

A hormone produced mainly by adipose tissue that signals stored-energy status to the brain and influences appetite and energy balance.

## Leptomeningeal Metastasis

Spread of cancer to the leptomeninges and cere-

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brospinal fluid (carcinomatous meningitis), causing multifocal neurologic deficits; managed with intrathecal chemotherapy and involved-field radiation.

### **Leptospirosis**

Leptospirosis is zoonotic infection with *Leptospira* bacteria acquired from water or soil contaminated by animal urine, ranging from fever and myalgia to kidney and liver failure. transmitted through contact with water or soil contaminated with the urine of infected animals (rodents, cattle, dogs). Incubation period 5-14 days. Mild form: fever, headache, myalgia (especially calves), conjunctival suffusion.

#### **Synonyms:**

Weils Disease (Leptospirosis)

### **Leriche Syndrome**

Aortoiliac occlusive disease causing reduced blood flow to the pelvis and lower limbs. The classic presentation includes buttock or thigh claudication, diminished femoral pulses, and erectile dysfunction, although symptoms vary with the extent of collateral circulation.

### **Lesion**

A general term for any abnormal change in tissue structure due to disease or injury.

### **Lesser Curvature**

Concave medial stomach border from gastroesophageal junction to pylorus. Attachment site for the lesser omentum connecting to the liver, containing right/left gastric arteries. Most common gastric ulcer site. The angular incisure marks the body-antrum junction. Cancer here may cause early obstruction from the narrow lumen.

### **Lesser Trochanter**

Small conical posteromedial proximal femoral prominence. Insertion for iliopsoas (primary hip flexor). Isolated fractures in adults may indicate pathologic fracture from metastatic disease; in adolescents may result from iliopsoas avulsion. Visible on lateral hip radiographs.

### **Lethal-Means Counseling**

A preventive intervention that reduces access to firearms, medications, toxic substances, or other methods of self-harm during periods of elevated risk. It is conducted collaboratively and is an important component of suicide prevention.

### **Leucocyte (White Blood Cell)**

A blood cell involved in immune defense against infection, foreign substances, and abnormal cells.

#### **Synonyms:**

White Blood Cell

### **Leucopenia**

A decreased total white blood cell count below the normal reference range ( $< 4.0 \times 10^9/L$ ). Leucopenia is often due to a decrease in neutrophils (neutropenia) or lymphocytes (lymphopenia).

### **Leukemia**

Leukemia is cancer of blood-forming cells that disrupts normal marrow production and may cause anemia, infection, bleeding, abnormal blood counts, and organ infiltration. Leukemias are classified by the cell lineage and by clinical course, including acute and chronic forms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Blood Cancer (Leukemia) Leukemia, General

### **Leukemia Cutis**

Infiltration of the skin by leukemic cells, presenting as papules, nodules, or plaques. It is more common in acute myeloid leukemia and indicates a poorer prognosis.

### **Leukemia Genetics**

Acute lymphoblastic leukemia (ALL): Philadelphia chromosome (t9;22), Hyperdiploidy, ETV6-RUNX1 fusion. Acute myeloid leukemia (AML): t8;21, t15;17 (APL), FLT3 mutations. Chronic myeloid leukemia (CML): Philadelphia chromosome (BCR-ABL).

### **Leukemic Infiltration Of The Gingiva**

Gingival enlargement caused by infiltration of



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leukemic cells, most commonly in acute myeloid leukemia, particularly the monocytic subtype. The gingiva becomes swollen, erythematous, friable, and may bleed spontaneously. It results from leukemic cell proliferation within the gingival connective tissue.

### Leukemoid Reaction

A marked reactive increase in the white-cell count, usually with prominent neutrophilia and immature granulocytes, caused by severe infection, inflammation, malignancy, or tissue injury. It resembles leukemia but is not a clonal hematologic malignancy.

### Leukocyte Adhesion Deficiency

LAD-I (ITGB2 mutation, CD18 deficiency): absent CD11/CD18 integrins → impaired neutrophil adhesion/transmigration → delayed umbilical cord separation (>30 days), recurrent soft tissue infections without pus formation (leukocytosis >20,000), poor wound healing, periodontitis. Severe: death by age 2 without HSCT.

### Leukocyte Alkaline Phosphatase

An enzyme activity measured in mature neutrophils using a cytochemical stain, historically reported as a leukocyte alkaline phosphatase (LAP) score. The score is typically low in chronic myeloid leukaemia and increased in many leukemoid reactions, infections, pregnancy, and other reactive states.

### Leukocytoclastic Vasculitis

A histopathologic pattern of small-vessel vasculitis characterized by neutrophilic debris, fibrinoid change, and vessel-wall inflammation. Clinically it often presents with palpable purpura; causes may be cutaneous-limited or associated with systemic disease.

### Leukocytosis

An increased total white blood cell count above the normal reference range ( $> 11 \times 10^9/\text{L}$  in adults).

### Leukonychia

White discoloration of the nails. True leukonychia: involves the nail matrix and moves distally with nail

growth (punctate, striate/Mees lines from arsenic poisoning, or total).

### Leukoplakia

Leukoplakia is a persistent white patch on mucosa that cannot be scraped away and may reflect irritation, infection, or premalignant epithelial change requiring evaluation. and cannot be characterized clinically as any other definable lesion (WHO). Leukoplakia is a potentially malignant disorder of the oral cavity, with a risk of malignant transformation to squamous cell carcinoma of approximately 1-5% per year.

#### Synonyms:

Smokers Keratosis (Leukoplakia)

### Leukopoiesis

The production and development of white blood cells (leukocytes) from hematopoietic stem cells in the bone marrow, regulated by colony-stimulating factors and interleukins.

### Leukotomy

A neurosurgical procedure involving the cutting of white matter fibers in the prefrontal cortex, also known as frontal lobotomy or prefrontal leukotomy. Developed by Egas Moniz (Nobel Prize 1949) and Walter Freeman.

#### Synonyms:

frontal lobotomy or prefrontal leukotomy.

### Levator Ani

The primary pelvic floor muscle complex supporting the pelvic organs, forming a hammock from the pubic symphysis to the coccyx. Composed of the pubococcygeus, puborectalis, and iliococcygeus muscles. Innervated by the pudendal nerve (S2-S4).

### Lewy Body Dementia

Dementia with visual hallucinations, parkinsonism, fluctuating cognition. Alpha-synuclein pathology. Treatment: cholinesterase inhibitors, avoid antipsychotics.

#### Synonyms:

Dementia, Lewy Body



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## Lewy Body Disease

A neurodegenerative disorder associated with abnormal neuronal alpha-synuclein aggregates. Dementia with Lewy bodies commonly features fluctuating cognition, recurrent visual hallucinations, REM sleep behavior disorder, and spontaneous parkinsonism; sensitivity to antipsychotics may occur.

## Leydig Cell Tumor

A testicular sex cord-stromal tumor that secretes testosterone or estrogen, causing precocious puberty or gynecomastia; most are benign and treated by orchidectomy.

## Lfgren Syndrome

Acute sarcoidosis with bilateral hilar lymphadenopathy, erythema nodosum, and ankle polyarthralgia. It often resolves spontaneously and generally has a favorable prognosis, although follow-up is needed. Associated with HLA-DR3.

## Li-Fraumeni Syndrome

An inherited cancer-predisposition syndrome most often caused by a pathogenic TP53 variant. It confers high lifetime risks of sarcomas, breast cancer, brain tumors, adrenocortical carcinoma, leukemia, and other early-onset malignancies.

## LI-RADS

Liver Imaging-Reporting and Data System. Standardizes reporting of liver imaging in patients with cirrhosis. Used for hepatocellular carcinoma diagnosis.

## Libido

Sexual desire or drive, influenced by biological, psychological, and social factors.

## Libido And Sexual Performance

Libido (sexual desire) is modulated by a complex interplay of hormonal (testosterone, estrogen, prolactin), neurologic, psychological, and relational factors.

## Lice

Pediculosis: infestation by blood-sucking lice—head lice (*Pediculus humanus capitis*, common in children, scalp), body lice (*Pediculus humanus corporis*, clothing/seams, associated with poor hygiene and epidemic typhus transmission), and pubic/crab lice (*Phthirus pubis*, sexually transmitted).

## Lice Infestations

Pediculosis is infestation by head, body, or pubic lice. Head lice cause scalp pruritus and nits attached to hair shafts; body lice live mainly in clothing; pubic lice affect coarse hair-bearing regions.

## Lichen

A descriptive dermatological term referring to a flat-topped, firm, papular skin lesion resembling the lichen plant (a symbiotic organism of algae and fungi growing on rocks and trees). Lichenoid describes lesions that resemble lichen planus or lichenoid drug eruptions.

## Lichen Planus

A T-cell mediated inflammatory condition affecting skin, mucous membranes, nails, and hair. Classic presentation: the 6 Ps (pruritic, purple, polygonal, planar, papules, plaques), often with Wickham striae (white lacy network on surface). Oral lichen planus affects buccal mucosa and may be erosive.

### Synonyms:

Lichen Ruber Planus (Lichen Planus)

## Lichen Sclerosus

A chronic inflammatory skin disease most commonly affecting anogenital skin. It presents as ivory-white, atrophic plaques with wrinkled paper-like appearance. In women, it predominantly affects the vulva and perianal region (figure-eight distribution). In men, it affects the glans penis and foreskin (balanitis xerotica obliterans).

### Synonyms:

White Spot Disease

## Lichen Simplex Chronicus

A thickened, leathery plaque caused by chronic scratching and rubbing (itch-scratch cycle). It com-

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monly affects the neck, ankles, lower legs, and genital area. It is a form of neurodermatitis associated with stress and anxiety.

### **Liddle Syndrome**

Autosomal dominant condition caused by gain-of-function mutations in the ENaC sodium channel subunits leading to constitutive sodium reabsorption and potassium secretion in the collecting duct. Presents with severe hypertension, hypokalemia, and metabolic alkalosis occurring in childhood or young adulthood.

### **Liddle Syndrome Treatment**

Liddle syndrome is an autosomal dominant cause of early-onset hypertension with hypokalemia and metabolic alkalosis caused by gain-of-function mutations in ENaC sodium channel subunits. Aldosterone levels are suppressed.

### **Life Expectancy**

The average number of additional years a person of a specified age is expected to live under current mortality conditions.

### **Ligament**

A dense, fibrous connective tissue band that connects bone to bone, providing passive joint stability and guiding joint motion. Ligaments are composed predominantly of type I collagen fibers (parallel orientation, crimped pattern) and elastin fibers (10-20% in some ligaments), arranged in bundles.

### **Ligand**

Any molecule that binds specifically to a biological receptor, macromolecule, or active site. In pharmacology and physiology, ligands include hormones, neurotransmitters, drugs, and toxins that bind receptors to initiate (agonist), block (antagonist), or modulate signaling.

### **Ligation**

The surgical process of tying off a blood vessel or duct using a suture or clip to prevent bleeding or block fluid flow.

### **Ligation (Vascular)**

Surgical tying, clipping, or sealing of a blood vessel to stop or redirect blood flow.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Ligature**

Any cord, wire, rope, fabric, or flexible object used to constrict the neck, bind limbs, suspend the body, or inflict injury. The resulting pale groove-shaped abrasion may be horizontal with petechiae in homicidal strangulation, or oblique and upward in hanging.

### **Light Therapy**

Treatment that uses selected wavelengths or intensity of light for conditions such as some skin disorders, seasonal depression, or neonatal jaundice.

### **Light's Criteria**

An effusion is exudative if any one is met: pleural protein/serum protein  $> 0.5$ , pleural LDH/serum LDH  $> 0.6$ , or pleural LDH  $> 2/3$  upper limit of normal serum LDH.

### **Light-Near Dissociation**

A pupillary abnormality in which the pupil does not constrict to light but does constrict during accommodation (near response). Classically seen in Argyll Robertson pupils (neurosyphilis) and also in midbrain lesions, diabetes mellitus, and optic nerve disease. Differentiates from tonic pupil (Adie pupil) by preserved near response.

### **Likelihood Ratio**

A ratio that describes how much a test result changes the odds of disease. The positive likelihood ratio is sensitivity divided by one minus specificity; the negative likelihood ratio is one minus sensitivity divided by specificity.

### **Limbic Encephalitis**

Inflammation of the limbic system, often presenting subacutely with memory impairment, seizures, psychiatric or behavioral change, and sleep disturbance. It may be autoimmune, paraneoplastic, infectious,

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or of unknown cause.

### **Limbic System**

A set of interconnected brain structures located in the medial temporal lobe and around the corpus callosum, involved in emotion, memory, motivation, behaviour, and autonomic regulation. The term was coined by Paul Broca (1878, *le grand lobe limbique*) and expanded by Papez (1937, Papez circuit) and MacLean (1952, 'visceral brain').

### **Linea Aspera**

Prominent longitudinal posterior femoral shaft ridge from converging muscle attachment lines. Insertion for adductor magnus, vastus medialis/lateralis, and short head of biceps femoris. Thickest femoral cortex, resisting bending forces. Diverges distally into supracondylar lines.

### **Linea Nigra**

A dark brown or black vertical line appearing on the abdomen during pregnancy, extending from the pubic symphysis to the umbilicus or beyond. Caused by hormonal stimulation of melanocytes, resulting in hyperpigmentation. More prominent in darker-skinned women.

### **Linear Energy Transfer**

Energy deposited per unit path length. High LET (alpha, neutrons) more biologically effective.

### **Linear IgA Bullous Dermatitis**

An autoimmune blistering disease caused by linear deposition of IgA at the basement membrane zone. It produces tense blisters, sometimes in annular or "string of pearls" patterns, and may be idiopathic or drug-induced.

### **Lingua Villosa Nigra**

A benign condition characterized by elongation and dark pigmentation of the filiform papillae of the tongue, often associated with tobacco use, poor oral hygiene, or antimicrobial therapy.

### **Lingual Artery**

A branch of the external carotid artery supplying the tongue, floor of mouth, and sublingual structures. It arises anterior to the hypoglossal nerve and courses deep to the hyoglossus muscle. Lingual artery aneurysm or thrombosis is rare but can cause life-threatening hemorrhage or tongue ischemia.

### **Linitis Plastica**

A diffuse infiltrative form of gastric carcinoma in which tumour cells spread through the stomach wall, producing marked thickening and rigidity with loss of normal distensibility. It may cause early satiety, weight loss, nausea, vomiting, or vague upper-abdominal symptoms.

### **Linkage**

Co-inheritance of nearby genetic markers and disease gene. Measured by recombination fraction (theta). LOD score >3 indicates linkage.

### **Lipase**

An enzyme that breaks down fats into smaller molecules. Blood lipase testing is commonly used when pancreatitis is suspected, although an abnormal result is not specific in every case.

### **Lipedema**

A chronic disorder of abnormal, usually symmetrical deposition of painful subcutaneous adipose tissue, predominantly affecting the legs and sometimes the arms. The feet and hands are typically spared, and easy bruising, tenderness, and progressive functional limitation may occur.

### **Lipemia Retinalis**

A creamy, pinkish-white discolouration of the retinal vessels caused by severely elevated serum triglycerides, typically exceeding 2,000 mg/dL. It is a sign of extreme hypertriglyceridaemia and indicates a risk for acute pancreatitis, requiring urgent lipid-lowering therapy and dietary management.

### **Lipid**

Diverse group of hydrophobic molecules including triglycerides (energy storage), phospholipids (mem-

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branes), cholesterol (membranes, steroid precursor), fat-soluble vitamins (A, D, E, K). Triglycerides: glycerol + 3 fatty acids. Fatty acids: saturated (no double bonds) vs. unsaturated (one or more double bonds).

### **Lipid Emulsion Therapy**

The antidote for local anesthetic systemic toxicity. The mechanism involves the lipid sink theory (lipid phase sequesters lipophilic local anesthetics from neural and cardiac tissue) and metabolic theory (lipid provides fatty acid substrate to ischemic myocardium).

### **Lipid Panel**

Measurement of total cholesterol, LDL-C, HDL-C, and triglycerides. Fasting (9-12 hours) or non-fasting acceptable for screening. Desirable levels: total cholesterol <200 mg/dL, LDL <100 mg/dL (<70 for very high risk), HDL >40 (men) or >50 (women) mg/dL, triglycerides <150 mg/dL.

### **Lipoatrophy**

Loss of subcutaneous adipose tissue at specific sites, most commonly caused by repeated subcutaneous injections of insulin or other medications, or associated with autoimmune conditions and HIV lipodystrophy.

### **Lipodystrophy**

Abnormal distribution or loss of body fat, which may be inherited or caused by medicines, metabolic disease, or repeated injections.

### **Lipodystrophy Syndromes**

Rare conditions characterized by selective loss of adipose tissue leading to severe insulin resistance, diabetes, and hypertriglyceridemia. Congenital generalized lipodystrophy involves loss of all body fat from birth. Familial partial lipodystrophy involves loss of limb and truncal fat with fat accumulation in face and neck.

### **Lipofuscin**

Lipofuscin is a yellow-brown, non-degradable pigment made of oxidized lipid and protein residues

that accumulates in long-lived cells with ageing and in some degenerative diseases.

### **Lipogenesis**

The synthesis of fatty acids and triglycerides from acetyl-CoA and other carbon sources. It occurs mainly in liver and adipose tissue when energy and carbohydrate are abundant and is stimulated by insulin.

### **Lipoid Nephrosis**

A historical term for minimal change disease, a glomerular disorder causing nephrotic syndrome through increased glomerular permeability to proteins. It is especially common in children and typically shows diffuse podocyte foot-process effacement on electron microscopy.

### **Lipoid Pneumonia**

Lung inflammation caused by accumulation of lipid-laden macrophages in the alveoli. Exogenous lipoid pneumonia results from aspiration of mineral oil, petroleum jelly, or oil-based nose drops. Endogenous lipoid pneumonia occurs distal to bronchial obstruction. HRCT shows ground-glass opacities with low-attenuation areas (fat density).

### **Lipolysis**

Hydrolysis of stored triglycerides in adipocytes to release non-esterified fatty acids and glycerol. It is stimulated by catecholamines and fasting-related hormonal signals and inhibited by insulin.

### **Lipoma**

The most common benign soft tissue tumor, composed of mature adipocytes. It presents as a soft, mobile, painless subcutaneous nodule, commonly on the trunk, neck, and proximal extremities. Lipomas grow slowly and may be multiple (familial multiple lipomatosis). Diagnosis is clinical; ultrasound or MRI for deep or atypical lesions.

### **Lipomatosis**

A rare condition characterized by the diffuse, symmetric, non-encapsulated proliferation of mature adipose tissue, most commonly affecting the pelvis

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and lower extremities. Unlike simple lipomas, lipomatosis involves infiltration of fat into surrounding structures without encapsulation, making surgical excision difficult.

### **Lipoprotein**

Complex of lipids and proteins transporting hydrophobic lipids in aqueous blood. Classes: chylomicrons (dietary lipids), VLDL (endogenous triglycerides), LDL (cholesterol delivery), HDL (reverse cholesterol transport). ApoB-100 in LDL; apoA-1 in HDL. Elevated LDL cholesterol is a major risk factor for atherosclerosis.

### **Lipoprotein Lipase**

Hydrolyzes triglycerides in chylomicrons and VLDL. Activated by insulin.

### **Lipoprotein Metabolism**

The production, transport, modification, and clearance of particles that carry lipids through the blood.

### **Liposarcoma**

A malignant tumor of fat cells, usually arising in the deep soft tissues of the thigh or retroperitoneum; well-differentiated, myxoid, and pleomorphic subtypes are recognized.

### **Liposomal Amphotericin B**

A liposomal formulation of amphotericin B used in the treatment of severe systemic fungal infections, with reduced nephrotoxicity compared to conventional amphotericin B. The liposomal formulation encapsulates amphotericin B within lipid vesicles, which alters the drug's biodistribution and reduces renal tubular damage.

### **Liquefactive Necrosis**

Characterized by the complete enzymatic digestion of dead cells, resulting in a liquid, viscous mass that eventually liquefies and forms a cystic cavity.

### **Liquid Biopsy**

Analysis of blood or another body fluid for cellular material, DNA, RNA, or other molecules released

by a tumor or other disease process.

### **Lisch Nodules**

Benign, dome-shaped melanocytic hamartomas on the iris, commonly seen in neurofibromatosis type 1. They usually do not affect vision and support the diagnosis when interpreted with other clinical findings.

### **Lissencephaly**

A severe brain malformation characterized by a smooth cerebral surface due to absent (agyria) or decreased (pachygyria) sulcation and gyration, caused by impaired neuronal migration during 12-16 weeks of gestation.

### **Listeria Monocytogenes**

A gram-positive, facultatively anaerobic rod that causes listeriosis, a foodborne infection. The organism is transmitted through contaminated food, particularly deli meats, soft cheeses, and ready-to-eat foods. It can grow at refrigeration temperatures.

### **Listeriosis**

Listeriosis is infection with *Listeria monocytogenes*, causing febrile gastroenteritis or invasive disease such as meningitis, especially in pregnancy, newborns, older adults, and immunocompromised people. food (deli meats, soft cheeses, unpasteurized dairy, produce). Risk groups: pregnant women (fever, flu-like illness), neonates (sepsis, meningitis), immunocompromised, and elderly.

### **Listeriosis In Pregnancy**

Infection with *Listeria monocytogenes*, a foodborne Gram-positive rod. Pregnant women are 10-20 times more susceptible than the general population. Ingestion of contaminated food (deli meats, soft cheeses, unpasteurized dairy, raw sprouts). Maternal symptoms: fever, myalgias, GI symptoms (nausea, diarrhea).

### **Lithiasis**

Stone formation. Nephrolithiasis, ureterolithiasis, cystolithiasis, urethrolithiasis.

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## Lithium Toxicity

A potentially life-threatening condition caused by lithium levels exceeding the therapeutic range (0.6–1.2 mEq/L). Mild toxicity (1.5–2.0 mEq/L): nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, coarse tremor, muscle weakness. Moderate toxicity (2.0–2.5 mEq/L): confusion, ataxia, blurred vision, dysarthria.

## Lithotripsy

Lithotripsy breaks urinary stones into smaller fragments using externally delivered shock waves or an endoscopic energy source so they can pass or be removed. smaller pieces that can pass through the urinary tract. See Shock Wave Lithotripsy.

## Lithotripsy Probe

A device that fragments a stone using mechanical, ultrasonic, laser, or shock-wave energy during a stone-removal procedure.

## Lithotripter Probe

A probe used to break urinary or biliary stones into smaller fragments for removal.

## Little Area

The highly vascular region of the anterior nasal septum where several arteries meet and where most anterior nosebleeds originate.

## Livedo Reticularis

A net-like, violaceous discoloration of the skin caused by altered blood flow in small cutaneous vessels. It may be temporary and cold-induced or associated with vascular, autoimmune, infectious, or clotting disorders.

## Liver

The largest internal organ, located in the right upper quadrant of the abdomen beneath the diaphragm.

## Liver Abscess

Focal collection of pus within the liver parenchyma. Pyogenic abscesses are most commonly from biliary tract infection or hematogenous spread from portal or systemic infection. Amoebic abscesses are caused

by *Entamoeba histolytica* predominantly in tropical regions. Presents with fever, right upper quadrant pain, and hepatomegaly.

## Liver Biopsy

Percutaneous, transjugular, or laparoscopic sampling of liver tissue for histological evaluation. Indicated for staging fibrosis, diagnosing specific liver diseases, and assessing treatment response. The procedure is guided by ultrasound for accuracy. Complications include bleeding, pain, and pneumothorax.

## Liver Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the liver. Hepatocellular carcinoma is the most common primary type in adults; risk factors include chronic liver disease, viral hepatitis, alcohol-related liver injury, and some toxins.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Liver

## Liver Cirrhosis

Advanced hepatic fibrosis with regenerative nodules surrounded by dense fibrous septa representing the end result of chronic liver injury. Common etiologies include chronic viral hepatitis, alcoholic liver disease, and nonalcoholic steatohepatitis.

## Liver Disease Diet

An individualized eating plan for a person with liver disease. It may address adequate energy and protein, sodium or fluid intake, alcohol avoidance, and nutrient deficiencies according to the condition.

## Liver Enzymes

ALT, AST, ALP, GGT. Markers of liver injury. ALT more specific for liver.

## Liver Failure

A life-threatening condition resulting from severe impairment of hepatic synthetic, metabolic, and detoxification functions.

## Liver Function Tests

Blood tests used to assess liver injury, bile-flow



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abnormalities, and liver synthetic function. They commonly include aminotransferases, alkaline phosphatase, bilirubin, albumin, and clotting tests; results must be interpreted together with the clinical context.

### **Liver Health**

Essential for metabolism, detoxification, protein synthesis, bile production, and immune function.

### **Liver Lobule**

The functional unit of the liver: a hexagonal structural unit centered on a central (hepatic) venule, with portal triads (portal vein, hepatic artery, bile ductule) at the corners.

### **Liver Mass**

Abnormality in liver detected on imaging. Benign: hemangioma, focal nodular hyperplasia, adenoma. Malignant: hepatocellular carcinoma, metastasis, cholangiocarcinoma.

### **Liver Transplant**

Surgical replacement of a diseased liver with a healthy liver or part of a liver from a donor.

### **Liver Transplantation**

Surgical replacement of a diseased liver with a healthy donor organ indicated for end-stage liver disease, acute liver failure, and select hepatocellular carcinomas within Milan criteria. Requires lifelong immunosuppression with calcineurin inhibitors, antimetabolites, and corticosteroids.

### **Living Will**

A type of advance directive that records a person's preferences for future medical treatment if the person cannot communicate or decide.

### **Living Will (Advance Statements)**

A legally binding written document that specifies a person's preferences for medical treatment if they become unable to make decisions for themselves in the future (loss of capacity). Living wills are a type of advance directive (or advance decision/advance

statement in the UK).

#### **Synonyms:**

Advance Statements

### **Livor Mortis (Lividity)**

Post-mortem purplish-red discoloration of dependent body parts resulting from gravitational settling of blood in uncompressed capillaries and small veins following cessation of circulation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lividity

### **Livor Mortis (Postmortem Lividity)**

Purplish-red discoloration of dependent body parts following death, caused by gravitational pooling of blood in uncompressed capillaries and venules. Starts within 30 min–2 hours, becomes fixed after 6–12 hours.

#### **Synonyms:**

Postmortem Lividity

### **LLETZ**

Large Loop Excision of the Transformation Zone, also called LEEP (Loop Electrosurgical Excision Procedure). A common outpatient procedure used to diagnose and treat cervical intraepithelial neoplasia (CIN).

#### **Synonyms:**

LEEP (Loop Electrosurgical).

### **Loa Loa**

The African eye worm, a filarial nematode transmitted by Chrysops deer flies, endemic to the rainforests of West and Central Africa. Adult worms migrate subcutaneously, causing Calabar swellings, and may cross the subconjunctiva of the eye, causing visible worm migration. Microfilariae are detected in daytime peripheral blood.

### **Loading Dose**

A higher initial dose of a drug administered to rapidly achieve therapeutic plasma concentrations, followed by lower maintenance doses to sustain the steady state. The loading dose is calculated as: Loading dose = (Vd x desired concentration) /

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bioavailability.

### **Lobar Pneumonia**

Consolidation involving an entire lobe. Most commonly caused by *S. pneumoniae*. Classic progression: congestion, red hepatization, gray hepatization, resolution.

### **Lobectomy**

Surgical removal of a lobe of an organ. Most commonly lung lobectomy (removal of one lobe of the lung, performed for lung cancer, bronchiectasis, abscess, or benign tumor) or temporal lobectomy (removal of the anterior temporal lobe for drug-resistant temporal lobe epilepsy).

### **Local Anesthesia**

The reversible abolition of sensation in a circumscribed area by infiltration or topical application of local anesthetic agents (lidocaine, bupivacaine) without loss of consciousness. Maximum safe dosing must be observed to avoid systemic toxicity. Epinephrine prolongs duration but is avoided in end-arterial territories.

### **Local Anesthetic**

A medication that causes reversible loss of sensation in a specific, localized area of the body without affecting consciousness. Local anesthetics block voltage-gated sodium channels in nerve cell membranes, preventing action potential generation and propagation.

### **Local Anesthetic Systemic Toxicity**

A life-threatening complication caused by elevated plasma concentration of local anesthetic, most commonly from inadvertent intravascular injection or rapid absorption.

### **Local Anesthetic Toxicity**

CNS toxicity: tinnitus, perioral numbness, seizures. Cardiovascular toxicity: arrhythmias, hypotension, cardiac arrest. Treatment: lipid emulsion therapy (Intralipid), seizure control, ACLS.

### **Local Invasion**

Tumor growth into surrounding tissues. Distinguishes malignant from benign.

### **Lochia**

Vaginal discharge following delivery that undergoes characteristic changes over the puerperium. Lochia rubra (days 1-4): red, bloody discharge containing blood, decidual tissue, and fetal membranes. Lochia serosa (days 5-10): pinkish-brown discharge with serous fluid, leukocytes, and organisms.

### **Locked-In Syndrome**

A neurological condition in which the patient is fully conscious and aware but cannot move or speak due to complete paralysis of all voluntary muscles except for vertical eye movements and blinking (total locked-in syndrome: loss of all eye movements).

#### **Synonyms:**

Locked In Syndrome (Locked-In Syndrome)

### **Lockjaw (Tetanus)**

A serious neurologic illness caused by tetanospasmin produced by *Clostridium tetani*. It causes painful muscle stiffness and spasms, often beginning in the jaw.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tetanus

### **Locomotor Ataxia (Tabes Dorsalis)**

A late manifestation of untreated tertiary syphilis (neurosyphilis) caused by infection with *Treponema pallidum*, involving progressive degeneration of the dorsal columns (fasciculus gracilis and cuneatus) and dorsal roots of the spinal cord.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tabes Dorsalis

### **Locus**

Specific position of gene on chromosome. Designated by chromosome number, arm (p/q), band, subband. Example: 7q31.2 (CFTR gene).

### **Loneliness**

Subjective feeling of isolation. Associated with de-

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pression, cognitive decline, mortality.

### **Long COVID**

Long COVID is a condition of persistent or newly developing symptoms after SARS-CoV-2 infection, potentially involving fatigue, exertional intolerance, cognition, breathing, autonomic function, or multiple organs. Several weeks and sometimes months or years. Common manifestations include fatigue, post-exertional malaise, cognitive difficulty, breathlessness, dysautonomia, and altered smell or taste.

### **Long QT Syndrome**

A disorder of cardiac repolarization that prolongs the QT interval and increases the risk of torsades de pointes and sudden cardiac death. It may be inherited or acquired from medicines, electrolyte abnormalities, or other conditions.

### **Long-Acting Beta-2 Agonists**

Bronchodilators that provide sustained relaxation of airway smooth muscle for maintenance treatment of asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. In asthma, they are used with an inhaled corticosteroid rather than alone.

### **Long-Term Care**

Assistance with ADLs/IADLs for extended period. Settings: home, assisted living, nursing home. Funding: Medicaid, long-term care insurance, out-of-pocket. Planning essential for elderly and families.

### **Long-Term Effect**

A health effect that develops or persists after prolonged exposure, treatment, or disease. It may be beneficial, harmful, or uncertain.

### **Long-Term Rehabilitation**

Chronic condition management. Focus on maintaining function, preventing complications.

### **Loop Diuretics**

A class of potent diuretics that act on the thick ascending limb of the loop of Henle by inhibiting the sodium-potassium-chloride cotransporter, blocking

sodium and chloride reabsorption and producing a powerful natriuresis and diuresis. The prototypical loop diuretic is furosemide, with other agents including bumetanide and torsemide.

### **Loop Of Henle**

U-shaped tubular segment consisting of a thin descending limb, thin ascending limb, and thick ascending limb. The descending limb is permeable to water but not solutes, allowing water reabsorption into the hypertonic medullary interstitium.

### **Loratadine**

A second-generation (non-sedating) H1 antihistamine used for allergic rhinitis and chronic urticaria. Peripherally selective—minimal CNS penetration, minimal anticholinergic effects. Once daily; prodrug (desloratadine is active). Adverse effects: headache, dry mouth, and rare sedation. Available OTC.

### **Lordosis**

The normal inward curvature of the cervical and lumbar spine. Excessive lumbar lordosis (hyperlordosis): increased pelvic tilt, commonly due to hip flexor tightness, weak abdominals, or pregnancy. Presents with low back pain and forward protrusion of the abdomen and buttocks.

### **Loss Of Appetite**

Reduced desire to eat. It may result from illness, medicines, mood disorders, pain, or other causes.

### **Loss-Of-Function Variant**

A genetic variant that reduces or abolishes the normal activity of the encoded gene product. Disease risk depends on the gene, inheritance pattern, residual function, and whether one or both copies are affected.

### **Low Back Pain**

Pain or discomfort in the lower back, commonly caused by muscle or ligament strain, disc disease, arthritis, or spinal nerve irritation. Weakness, numbness, new bladder or bowel problems, fever, major trauma, or unexplained weight loss are warning signs requiring prompt medical assessment.

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**Synonyms:**

Lumbago (Low Back Pain)

**Low Birth Weight**

Birth weight <2500 g, often due to prematurity and/or intrauterine growth restriction; further classified: very low (<1500 g), extremely low (<1000 g), and small for gestational age.

**Low FODMAP Diet**

Dietary intervention for irritable bowel syndrome that restricts fermentable oligosaccharides, disaccharides, monosaccharides, and polyols, which are short-chain carbohydrates poorly absorbed in the small intestine and rapidly fermented by colonic bacteria producing gas and drawing water into the intestinal lumen.

**Low Molecular Weight Heparin**

A shorter heparin preparation that predominantly inhibits factor Xa through antithrombin and is used to prevent or treat thrombosis.

**Low Testosterone (Hypogonadism)**

Low testosterone (male hypogonadism) is a clinical syndrome of deficient testosterone production by the testes (primary) or inadequate stimulation by the pituitary/hypothalamus (secondary), defined as total testosterone <300 ng/dL on two morning measurements with consistent symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

Hypogonadism

**Low Vision**

Visual impairment that cannot be fully corrected with spectacles, contact lenses, medication, or surgery, impairing daily activities. Managed with low-vision aids (magnifiers, telescopes, adaptive devices), lighting, and occupational therapy.

**Low-Dose CT Scan**

CT protocol using reduced radiation for lung cancer screening. Detects small nodules at earlier stages. False positives require follow-up per Fleischner guidelines.

**Low-Phosphorus Diet**

A dietary pattern limiting phosphorus intake for selected patients with chronic kidney disease or persistent hyperphosphatemia. It emphasizes avoidance of phosphate additives while maintaining adequate protein and overall nutritional status.

**Low-Potassium Diet**

A dietary pattern limiting potassium intake when clinically indicated, usually for hyperkalemia or advanced kidney disease. It must be individualized because unnecessary restriction can reduce diet quality and cause inadequate intake of fruits and vegetables.

**Low-Residue Diet**

A short-term diet limiting dietary fiber and foods that leave substantial undigested material in the bowel. It may be used in selected gastrointestinal conditions or around certain procedures but is not a universal treatment for inflammatory bowel disease.

**Lower Airway Obstruction**

Narrowing of airways below the carina, causing expiratory wheezing and airflow obstruction on spirometry. Causes include asthma, COPD, bronchiectasis, and foreign body. It is characterized by scooped-out expiratory limb on flow-volume loops and reduced FEV1/FVC ratio.

**Lower Extremity Venous Doppler**

An ultrasound examination of the leg veins that assesses compressibility and blood flow, commonly to evaluate suspected deep venous thrombosis.

**Lower Motor Neuron Syndrome**

A pattern caused by injury to an anterior horn cell, motor cranial-nerve nucleus, nerve root, plexus, or peripheral motor nerve. It typically causes weakness, reduced tone and reflexes, muscle atrophy, and fasciculations in affected muscles.

**Lower Urinary Tract Symptoms**

Urinary symptoms arising from the bladder, bladder outlet, or urethra, classified as storage symptoms, voiding symptoms, and post-micturition symptoms. Causes include benign prostatic obstruction, overac-

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tive bladder, infection, neurologic disease, stricture, and malignancy.

### **Ludwig Angina**

A rapidly spreading cellulitis of the floor of the mouth and submandibular spaces, usually arising from an infected lower molar. Tongue elevation, dysphagia, drooling, and airway obstruction can develop rapidly and require emergency management.

### **Ludwig's Angina**

A rapidly progressive, life-threatening cellulitis of the submandibular, sublingual, and submental spaces, typically originating from an odontogenic infection of the lower second or third molars.

### **Lugano Classification**

Staging and response assessment for lymphoma.

### **Lumbago**

A non-specific term for low back pain, typically referring to acute or chronic pain in the lumbar region (between the lower ribs and the gluteal folds). Lumbago is a symptom, not a diagnosis.

### **Lumbar Disc Herniation**

Protrusion or extrusion of lumbar disc material through the annulus fibrosus, which may irritate or compress a nerve root and cause back or leg pain. Symptoms, examination findings, and imaging determine its significance and treatment.

### **Lumbar Puncture**

Insertion of a needle into the lower spinal canal to obtain cerebrospinal fluid or administer selected medicines.

### **Lumbar Puncture (Spinal Tap)**

Insertion of a needle into the subarachnoid space at L3-L4 or L4-L5 to obtain CSF. Indications: suspected meningitis/encephalitis, subarachnoid hemorrhage, demyelinating disease, and intrathecal therapy. Contraindications: increased intracranial pressure (papilledema, mass lesion on CT), coagulopathy, and infection at the puncture site.

### **Synonyms:**

Spinal Tap

### **Lumbar Radiculopathy**

A condition caused by compression, irritation, or inflammation of a spinal nerve root in the lumbar spine, resulting in pain radiating into the lower extremity along the distribution of the affected nerve root (sciatica). The most commonly affected nerve roots are L4, L5, and S1.

### **Lumbar Vertebrae**

Largest and strongest mobile vertebrae for weight-bearing. Large kidney-shaped bodies, short hatchet-shaped spinous processes, sagittally-oriented facets allowing primarily flexion/extension. Lordotic curvature. Most common disc herniation site, particularly L4-L5 and L5-S1 causing sciatica.

### **Lumpectomy**

Breast-conserving surgery excising a malignant lesion with a margin of normal tissue, combined with whole-breast radiation to yield survival equivalent to mastectomy for early-stage cancer. An acceptable margin is no ink on tumor for invasive cancer and 2 mm for ductal carcinoma in situ.

### **Lunate**

Crescent-shaped proximal row carpal bone between scaphoid and triquetrum. Most commonly dislocated carpal bone from falls on extended wrists. Dislocation may compress the median nerve causing acute carpal tunnel syndrome. Vulnerable to avascular necrosis (Kienbock disease) from its precarious blood supply.

### **Lung**

The paired, cone-shaped respiratory organs located in the thoracic cavity, responsible for gas exchange (oxygen uptake, carbon dioxide elimination). Each lung is divided into lobes: the right lung has three (superior, middle, inferior), the left lung has two (superior, inferior) with a cardiac notch accommodating the heart.



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## Lung Abscess

Localized necrosis with cavitation containing purulent material. Causes include aspiration and anaerobic bacteria. CXR shows thick-walled cavity with air-fluid level.

## Lung Cancer

Leading cancer death worldwide. Types: small cell, non-small cell. Risk factors: smoking, radon, asbestos.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Lung Cancer In Lung (Lung Cancer)

## Lung Compliance

The change in lung volume produced by a given change in transpulmonary pressure. Reduced compliance increases the work of breathing, whereas excessive compliance may occur when elastic recoil is lost, as in emphysema.

## Lung Disease

Lung disease encompasses disorders affecting the airways, parenchyma, pleura, pulmonary vasculature, and chest wall.

## Lung Function Tests

Physiologic tests that measure aspects of breathing, including airflow, lung volumes, and gas transfer, to assess respiratory function.

## Lung Herniation

Protrusion of lung tissue through a defect in the chest wall, most commonly occurring after thoracic trauma, thoracotomy, or in association with rib fractures and chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. Presents with a reducible chest wall mass that increases with coughing or straining and may cause pain and respiratory compromise.

## Lung Protective Ventilation

A ventilation strategy using low tidal volumes (6 mL/kg ideal body weight), plateau pressure < 30 cmH<sub>2</sub>O, appropriate PEEP, and permissive hypercapnia to minimize ventilator-induced lung injury. It is the standard of care for ARDS and is used

in all mechanically ventilated patients to reduce barotrauma, volutrauma, and biotrauma.

## Lung Transplant

Surgical replacement of one or both lungs from a donor for end-stage lung disease: COPD (most common), idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis, cystic fibrosis, pulmonary hypertension, and other advanced conditions. Types: single, bilateral, heart-lung.

## Lung Transplantation

Surgical replacement of a diseased lung with a healthy lung from a donor. Indications include IPF, COPD, CF, PAH, and bronchiectasis. Options include single lung transplant, double lung transplant, or heart-lung transplant. Post-transplant immunosuppression is required lifelong. Complications include rejection and infection.

## Lupus

A group of autoimmune diseases in which the immune system attacks the body's own tissues. Systemic lupus erythematosus may affect the skin, joints, kidneys, blood cells, nervous system, and other organs. Also called SLE.

### Synonyms:

SLE.

## Lupus Erythematosus

Systemic lupus erythematosus is a chronic autoimmune disease characterized by production of autoantibodies against nuclear antigens, leading to immune complex-mediated inflammation and tissue damage in multiple organ systems. The disease predominantly affects women of childbearing age, with a striking female predominance of 9 to 1.

## Lupus Erythematosus (Systemic Lupus Erythematosus - SLE)

A chronic multisystem autoimmune disease predominantly affecting women (9:1 female:male) of childbearing age, characterized by autoantibody production (ANA 98%, anti-dsDNA 70%, anti-Sm 30%) and immune complex deposition causing tissue injury.

### Synonyms:



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Systemic Lupus Erythematosus - SLE

### **Lupus Nephritis**

Kidney inflammation caused by systemic lupus erythematosus. It can cause blood or protein in the urine, high blood pressure, and reduced kidney function. Classification is based largely on kidney-biopsy findings, and treatment depends on the class, severity, kidney function, and individual risks.

### **Lupus Pernio**

A chronic, violaceous skin lesion of the face and extremities associated with sarcoidosis, indicating a higher risk of systemic involvement and chronic disease.

### **Lupus Vulgaris**

A chronic, progressive form of cutaneous tuberculosis (TB of the skin) caused by *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*. Once common in Europe, now rare in developed countries but still seen in developing regions.

### **Luteinizing Hormone**

LH: a gonadotropin secreted by the anterior pituitary, regulating gonadal steroidogenesis. In females: stimulates theca cells to produce androgens (aromatized to estradiol); mid-cycle LH surge triggers ovulation (used in ovulation prediction and timing of intercourse/IVF). In males: stimulates Leydig cells to produce testosterone.

### **Lutetium-177**

Beta and gamma emitter, half-life 6.7 days. Used in peptide receptor radionuclide therapy (PRRT) and PSMA therapy. Both therapeutic and imaging capabilities.

### **Lyme Disease**

A tick-borne infection caused by *Borrelia burgdorferi* (*Ixodes scapularis*, deer tick), endemic to the northeastern and upper midwestern US. Early localized: erythema migrans (bullseye rash, >5cm) at tick bite site, fatigue, fever, myalgia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis Lyme (Lyme Disease)

### **Lymph**

A clear, watery fluid that circulates through the lymphatic system, derived from interstitial fluid that has entered the lymphatic capillaries.

### **Lymph Node / Gland**

Small, bean-shaped organs of the lymphatic system that filter lymph and serve as sites for immune cell activation. Lymph nodes are distributed throughout the body (approximately 500-600 in total) and are concentrated in regions: cervical, axillary, inguinal, mediastinal, mesenteric, para-aortic, and iliac chains.

### **Lymph Node Dissection**

Removal of lymph nodes for staging or treatment. Sentinel node biopsy less invasive alternative.

### **Lymph Node Structure**

Small bean-shaped lymphoid organs (1-25 mm) distributed along lymphatic vessels, filtering lymph and mounting immune responses. Each has a cortex (outer, containing B-cell follicles with germinal centers), paracortex (deep cortex, containing T-cells and dendritic cells), and medulla (inner, containing medullary cords and sinuses).

### **Lymphadenectomy**

Surgical removal of lymph nodes, either sentinel or regional, for staging or therapeutic purposes; examples include axillary, inguinal, cervical, and retroperitoneal lymph node dissection.

### **Lymphadenitis**

Lymphadenitis is inflammation or infection of lymph nodes, causing localized tenderness and enlargement from bacterial, viral, mycobacterial, cat-scratch, or other disease. infection. Affected nodes may be tender, warm, or fluctuant, and the condition may be localized or generalized.

### **Lymphadenopathy**

Enlargement of lymph nodes (greater than 1 cm in diameter, or >1.5 cm for inguinal nodes). Lymphadenopathy can be localised (single or contiguous region) or generalised (three or more non-contiguous

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regions).

### **Lymphangiectasis**

Abnormal dilatation of lymphatic vessels. It may be congenital or acquired and can cause lymph leakage, oedema, protein-losing enteropathy, chylous effusions, or pulmonary and pleural complications depending on the affected site.

### **Lymphangiography**

Contrast imaging of lymphatic vessels. Evaluates lymphatic obstruction, fistulas. Largely replaced by MRI/CT.

### **Lymphangi leiomyomatosis**

A rare, progressive cystic lung disease caused by proliferation of abnormal smooth muscle-like cells (LAM cells) in the lungs, lymphatics, and kidneys. It occurs almost exclusively in women of childbearing age. HRCT shows thin-walled cysts throughout both lungs. It may be associated with tuberous sclerosis complex.

### **Lymphangioma**

A benign congenital malformation of the lymphatic system, composed of dilated lymphatic channels. Lymphangiomas are typically present at birth (90% diagnosed by age 2) and result from failure of the lymphatic system to develop normal connections with the venous system.

### **Lymphangitis**

Inflammation and infection of lymphatic vessels, usually spreading from an infected skin wound or cellulitis; tender red streaks, fever, and enlarged regional lymph nodes may occur.

### **Lymphatic System**

A network of lymphatic vessels, lymph nodes, and lymphoid organs (tonsils, thymus, spleen, Peyer patches) that returns interstitial fluid (lymph) to the bloodstream, transports dietary fat (chyle), and serves as the conduit for immune surveillance.

### **Lymphedema**

Persistent swelling caused by accumulation of lymphatic fluid in tissues, usually in an arm or leg.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphatic Obstruction (Lymphedema)

### **Lymphedema (Lymphoedema)**

Chronic swelling of a body part due to impaired lymphatic drainage, leading to accumulation of protein-rich interstitial fluid. Primary lymphedema: caused by congenital or hereditary lymphatic maldevelopment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphoedema

### **Lymphedema Management**

Measures used to reduce swelling and preserve function, including compression, exercise, skin care, and selected forms of manual lymphatic therapy.

### **Lymphocyte**

A type of white blood cell (leukocyte) that is the primary cellular component of the adaptive immune system. Lymphocytes account for 20-40% of circulating white blood cells ( $1.0\text{--}4.8 \times 10^9/\text{L}$ ). Three main types: (1) T lymphocytes (T cells): develop in the thymus, responsible for cell-mediated immunity.

### **Lymphocytic Colitis**

Chronic inflammatory bowel disease characterized by increased intraepithelial lymphocytes exceeding twenty per one hundred surface epithelial cells in the colonic mucosa without significant subepithelial collagen band thickening.

#### **Synonyms:**

Colitis Collagenous (Lymphocytic Colitis) Colitis Lymphocytic (Lymphocytic Colitis) Colitis Microscopic (Lymphocytic Colitis)

### **Lymphocytic Interstitial Pneumonia**

A rare ILD characterized by diffuse polyclonal lymphocytic infiltration of the lung parenchyma. It is strongly associated with Sjgren syndrome and HIV. HRCT shows ground-glass opacities, thin-walled cysts, and lymphadenopathy. Treatment is corticosteroids.

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teroids for symptomatic disease.

### **Lymphocytopenia**

A reduced lymphocyte count ( $< 1.0 \times 10^9/L$ ). Causes: acute (stress, steroids, sepsis, trauma, burns), infections (HIV, viral, tuberculosis, typhoid), immunosuppressive drugs, radiation, marrow failure (aplasia, leukemia, lymphoma), autoimmune (SLE), and congenital immunodeficiencies.

### **Lymphogranuloma Venereum**

Lymphogranuloma venereum is a sexually transmitted infection caused by invasive *Chlamydia trachomatis* strains, often producing a small lesion followed by painful regional lymphadenopathy or proctitis. L1–L3, classically producing transient genital lesions and painful inguinal lymphadenopathy.

### **Lymphokine**

A cytokine produced by lymphocytes (a subset of cytokines; the term lymphokine is largely historical, now 'cytokine'). Examples: IL-2, IL-4, IFN-gamma (from T cells), and B-cell growth factors. Mediate lymphocyte communication, activation, and regulation of immune responses.

### **Lymphoma**

A malignancy of lymphocytes, divided into Hodgkin lymphoma (HL—Reed-Sternberg cells, cervical/supraclavicular nodes, B symptoms, younger adults) and non-Hodgkin lymphoma (NHL—heterogeneous, more common, aggressive or indolent).

### **Lymphoma (Hodgkin's And Non-Hodgkin's)**

A group of cancers arising from lymphocytes, including Hodgkin lymphoma and the many types of non-Hodgkin lymphoma.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hodgkin's and Non-Hodgkin's

### **Lymphopoiesis**

The production and maturation of lymphocytes from hematopoietic stem and progenitor cells. It

occurs in primary lymphoid organs such as bone marrow and thymus and continues in peripheral lymphoid tissues during immune responses.

### **Lymphoscintigraphy**

Lymphatic system imaging using Tc-99m nanocolloid injected near lesion. Used for sentinel lymph node biopsy (melanoma, breast cancer), lymphedema evaluation.

### **Lynch Syndrome**

Hereditary nonpolyposis colorectal cancer syndrome caused by mismatch repair gene mutations including MLH1, MSH2, MSH6, and PMS2 with autosomal dominant inheritance. It increases the risk of colorectal, endometrial, ovarian, gastric, and urinary tract cancers.

### **Lysergic Acid Diethylamide**

A potent hallucinogenic drug (psychedelic) classified as a Schedule 1 controlled substance (high abuse potential, no accepted medical use). LSD acts as a partial agonist at serotonin 5-HT<sub>2A</sub> receptors in the prefrontal cortex, leading to altered sensory perception, mood, and cognition.

### **Lysogenic Conversion**

The acquisition of new properties (genes) by a bacterium when a temperate bacteriophage integrates its genome as a prophage and expresses phage-encoded genes.

### **Lysosome**

Membrane-bound organelles containing hydrolytic enzymes (acid hydrolases: proteases, lipases, nucleases, glycosidases) functioning at low pH (4.5–5.0) maintained by V-ATPase proton pump. Degrade macromolecules from endocytosis, phagocytosis, and autophagy.

### **Labile Hypertension**

Blood pressure that fluctuates substantially over short periods.

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**Lactase**

An enzyme that breaks down the milk sugar lactose in the small intestine.

**Lacunar Stroke**

An ischemic stroke caused by blockage of a small artery deep within the brain.

**Langerhans Cells**

Immune cells in the epidermis that capture antigens and help initiate immune responses.

**Laser Photocoagulation**

A laser treatment that seals or destroys abnormal blood vessels, especially in the retina.

**Laser Prostatectomy**

A procedure that uses laser energy to remove or vaporize enlarged prostate tissue.

**Learned Insomnia**

Persistent difficulty sleeping that is maintained by anxiety and conditioned behaviors associated with sleep.

**Left Ventricular Hypertrophy**

Thickening of the muscular wall of the heart's left ventricle.

**Left-Ventricular Assist Device**

An implanted mechanical pump that helps the left ventricle circulate blood.

**Leukotriene Modifiers**

Medicines that reduce asthma or allergy symptoms by blocking leukotriene production or action.

**Liothyronine Sodium**

A synthetic form of the thyroid hormone triiodothyronine used in selected thyroid disorders.

**Lumbar Stenosis**

Narrowing of the spinal canal or nerve openings in the lower back.

**Synonyms:**

Stenosis Lumbar (Lumbar Stenosis) Stenosis Spinal (Lumbar Stenosis)

**Labyrinth Disorder**

A disorder of the inner-ear balance structures that may cause vertigo, nausea, or imbalance.

**Laryngostenosis**

Narrowing of the larynx that can restrict airflow.

**Latent Tuberculosis**

Infection with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* in which the bacteria remain inactive and cause no symptoms but may later become active.

**Lymphangiomatosis**

An uncommon disorder involving excessive or abnormal growth of lymphatic vessels in one or more tissues.

**Lateral Decubitus Position**

A side-lying position in which the patient rests on the nonoperative side to provide access to the chest, hip, or flank.

**Lloyd-Davies Position**

A modified lithotomy position in which the hips and knees are flexed and the legs are supported, commonly for pelvic or colorectal surgery.

**Lithotomy Position**

A supine position in which the hips and knees are flexed and the legs are raised and supported to provide access to the pelvis and perineum.

**Lazy Eye**

Reduced vision in one eye caused by abnormal visual development during childhood; also called amblyopia.

**Synonyms:**

amblyopia.

**Lip Cancer**

Cancer that develops in the tissues of the upper or

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lower lip.

### **Listeria Infection**

An infection caused by *Listeria* bacteria, often acquired from contaminated food.

### **Liver Disease**

Any disorder that damages or impairs the structure or function of the liver.

### **Liver Fibrosis**

Excessive formation of scar tissue in the liver after ongoing injury or inflammation.

### **Lobular Carcinoma In Situ**

Abnormal cells confined to the breast lobules that increase the risk of developing invasive breast cancer.

### **Low Sex Drive In Women**

Persistently reduced sexual desire in a woman that causes personal distress.

### **Low Sperm Count**

A semen condition in which the sperm concentration is below the expected reference range.

### **Lacteals**

Lymphatic vessels in intestinal villi that absorb dietary fats.

### **Laryngopharynx**

The lower part of the pharynx that connects the throat with the larynx and esophagus.

### **Laser**

A device that produces a concentrated beam of light used for diagnosis, treatment, or surgery.

### **Lavage**

Washing or irrigating a body cavity, organ, or wound with fluid.

### **Leptomeninges**

The arachnoid mater and pia mater, the two delicate inner membranes covering the brain and spinal cord.

### **Leukocytes**

White blood cells that help defend the body against infection and other threats.

### **Leukorrhea**

A whitish vaginal discharge that may be normal or may indicate infection or another disorder.

### **Lichenification**

Thickening and accentuation of skin markings caused by chronic scratching or rubbing.

### **Lingual Tonsils**

Collections of lymphoid tissue at the base of the tongue.

### **Lumen**

The inner space of a hollow organ, vessel, or tube.

### **Langer Lines**

Natural lines of skin tension that reflect the predominant orientation of collagen fibers in the dermis and may influence surgical scar direction.

### **Labiaplasty**

Surgical reshaping or reduction of the labia, usually the labia minora, performed for functional symptoms, reconstruction, or selected cosmetic indications. Risks include pain, bleeding, infection, scarring, and altered sensation.

### **Lemierre Syndrome**

A potentially severe oropharyngeal infection complicated by septic thrombophlebitis of the internal jugular vein and frequently metastatic infection, classically caused by *Fusobacterium necrophorum*.

### **Legionnaires Disease**

A severe pneumonia caused by *Legionella* bacteria, usually acquired by inhaling contaminated water aerosols. It may also cause gastrointestinal symp-

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toms, confusion, and low serum sodium.

### **Labral Tear**

A tear in the fibrocartilaginous rim of a joint socket, commonly the shoulder or hip, causing pain, clicking, instability, or reduced range of motion.

### **Laryngeal Edema**

Swelling of the tissues of the larynx that can narrow the upper airway and cause hoarseness, stridor, or respiratory distress. It may result from allergy, infection, trauma, or airway instrumentation.

### **Leukopenia**

An abnormally low white-blood-cell count, which may increase susceptibility to infection depending on the cells affected and the severity of the reduction.

### **Lymphocytosis**

An abnormally increased number or proportion of lymphocytes in the blood, often associated with viral infection, some bacterial infections, or lymphoproliferative disorders.

### **Lung Nodule**

A rounded, usually well-defined opacity in the lung measuring up to 3 cm on imaging. It may be benign, infectious, inflammatory, or an early manifestation of lung cancer and often requires follow-up assessment.

### **Labia**

The folds of skin surrounding the entrance to the vagina and urethra, consisting mainly of the labia majora and labia minora.

### **Lactobacillus**

A genus of bacteria that produces lactic acid and normally forms part of the healthy vaginal and intestinal microbiota; some species are used as probiotics.

### **Larva Migrans**

A condition caused by migrating larval parasites in human tissues, including cutaneous larva migrans

in the skin and visceral larva migrans in internal organs.

### **Laryngeal Stridor**

A harsh, high-pitched noise caused by turbulent airflow through a narrowed upper airway, often most noticeable during inspiration.

### **Legg-Calvé-Perthes Disease (Perthes Disease)**

A childhood disorder in which the blood supply to the femoral head is temporarily impaired, causing avascular necrosis, hip pain, stiffness, and possible deformity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Perthes Disease

### **Leptomeningitis**

Inflammation or infection of the leptomeninges, the arachnoid and pia mater covering the brain and spinal cord.

### **Leucoderma (Vitiligo)**

Loss of skin pigment producing sharply defined pale or white patches, usually because melanocytes have been destroyed or have stopped functioning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vitiligo

### **Leucorrhoea (Leukorrhoea)**

A whitish vaginal discharge that may be physiological or may result from infection, inflammation, or another genital disorder.

#### **Synonyms:**

Leukorrhoea

### **Living Will (Advance Directive)**

A document stating a person's preferences for future medical treatment if they later lose the capacity to make or communicate decisions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Advance Directive

### **Lactational Amenorrhea**

Temporary absence of menstrual periods during



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breastfeeding, caused by suppression of ovulation. It may provide contraceptive protection only when strict criteria for the lactational-amenorrhea method are met.

### **Labetalol**

Labetalol blocks beta-adrenergic receptors and selectively alpha-1 receptors to lower blood pressure; it is used in hypertension, including severe hypertension in pregnancy, and may cause bradycardia, hypotension, or bronchospasm.

### **Labium Majus**

One of the paired outer folds of the vulva containing skin, connective tissue, glands, vessels, and nerves and protecting the more internal genital structures.

### **Labium Minus**

One of the paired inner folds of the vulva bordering the vestibule and helping protect the urethral and vaginal openings.

### **Labor Complication**

A clinical condition or finding involving labor complication. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Labor Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving labor pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Laboratory**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to laboratory. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Laboratory Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laboratory procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Labradimil**

An investigational pharmacologic compound; its

mechanism, indication, safety, and clinical significance depend on the specific study or product context.

### **Labyrinthine Membrane**

The membranous labyrinth of the inner ear, a fluid-filled system containing the cochlear duct and vestibular organs responsible for hearing and balance.

### **Lac Operon**

A bacterial gene-regulation system controlling lactose metabolism through the lacZ, lacY, and lacA genes under control of a promoter and repressor.

### **Lacosamide**

Lacosamide is an antiseizure medicine that enhances slow inactivation of voltage-gated sodium channels; it treats focal seizures and can cause dizziness, diplopia, ataxia, and PR-interval prolongation.

### **Lacrimal Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving lacrimal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lactam**

A lactam is a cyclic amide formed when an amino group and carboxylic-acid group occur in the same molecule; beta-lactams such as penicillins and cephalosporins inhibit bacterial cell-wall synthesis.

### **Lactation Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving lactation disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lactobacillaceae**

lactobacillaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Lactobacillus Acidophilus**

lactobacillus acidophilus is a microorganism or mi-

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icrobial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Brevis**

*lactobacillus brevis* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Casei**

*lactobacillus casei* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Fermentum**

*lactobacillus fermentum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Gallinarum**

*lactobacillus gallinarum* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Gasseri**

*lactobacillus gasseri* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Jensenii**

*lactobacillus jensenii* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Johnsonii**

*lactobacillus johnsonii* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Oris**

*lactobacillus oris* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Paracasei**

*lactobacillus paracasei* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Rhamnosus**

*lactobacillus rhamnosus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Salivarius**

*lactobacillus salivarius* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactobacillus Vaginalis**

*lactobacillus vaginalis* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactococcus**

*lactococcus* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, ex-

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posure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactococcus Garvieae**

*lactococcus garvieae* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactococcus Lactis**

*lactococcus lactis* is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lactoferrin**

Lactoferrin is an iron-binding glycoprotein in milk and mucosal secretions that limits microbial iron access and contributes to innate immune defense.

### **Lactone**

A medical term referring to lactone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lactulose**

Lactulose is a non-absorbable synthetic disaccharide broken down by colonic bacteria; it softens stool for constipation and reduces intestinal ammonia absorption in hepatic encephalopathy, but can cause gas and diarrhoea.

### **Laetrile**

A semisynthetic amygdalin-related compound promoted as an alternative cancer treatment; credible evidence has not established anticancer benefit, and cyanide poisoning is a serious risk.

### **Lamellar Body**

A membrane-bound secretory organelle containing layered lipid material, especially in alveolar type II cells where it releases pulmonary surfactant.

### **Lamellipodium**

A medical term referring to lamellipodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lamin**

A biological or biochemical term involving lamin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lamina Propria**

A biological or biochemical term involving lamina propria. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Laminin**

A biological or biochemical term involving laminin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lamivudine**

Lamivudine is a nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor used with other antiretrovirals for HIV and as an antiviral for chronic hepatitis B; resistance and rare lactic acidosis or hepatic complications require monitoring.

### **Lamotrigine**

Lamotrigine is an antiseizure medicine that inhibits voltage-gated sodium channels and is also used for bipolar-maintenance treatment; rapid dose escalation increases the risk of serious rash including Stevens–Johnson syndrome.

### **Landolt Ring**

A medical term referring to landolt ring. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Langerhans' Cell**

Langerhans' cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

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## Language Development

Language development is the progressive acquisition of understanding, sounds, words, grammar, and communication during childhood.

## Language Disorder

A clinical condition or finding involving language disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Laniquidar

Laniquidar is an investigational inhibitor of drug-efflux transporters studied to overcome multidrug resistance in cancer cells.

## Lanolin

Lanolin is a waxy substance derived from sheep wool used as an emollient and in topical products; allergy or irritation can occur.

## Lanosterol

A medical term referring to lanosterol. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Lansoprazole

Lansoprazole is a proton-pump inhibitor that irreversibly suppresses gastric H<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup>-ATPase; it treats reflux and peptic-ulcer disease and helps eradicate *Helicobacter pylori*, while prolonged use may affect magnesium, vitamin B12, bone, and infection risk.

## Lanthanum

A medical term referring to lanthanum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Laparoscope

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving laparoscope. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Laparoscopic Colectomy

laparoscopic colectomy is used in relation to laparoscopic colectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Lapatinib

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called lapatinib. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## Lapatinib Ditosylate

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called lapatinib ditosylate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## Large Colon

The large colon is the main portion of the large intestine that absorbs water, stores fecal material, and moves contents toward the rectum.

## Laromustine

Laromustine is an investigational alkylating antineoplastic agent studied for DNA damage and cancer-cell killing.

## Larotaxel

Larotaxel is an investigational taxane that disrupts microtubules and has been studied for anticancer activity.

## Larva

A medical term referring to larva. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Laryngeal Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving laryngeal carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Laryngeal Cartilage

Laryngeal cartilage forms the structural framework of the voice box, maintains the airway, and supports vocal-fold movement.

## Laryngeal Cleft

A laryngeal cleft is a congenital opening between the airway and esophagus that can allow aspiration and cause feeding or breathing problems.

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### **Laryngeal Fistula**

A laryngeal fistula is an abnormal passage connecting the larynx with nearby tissue or the digestive tract and may cause aspiration or infection.

### **Laryngeal Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving laryngeal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Laryngeal Masks**

Laryngeal masks are supraglottic airway devices placed above the vocal cords to maintain ventilation during anesthesia or emergencies.

### **Laryngeal Mucositis**

Laryngeal mucositis is inflammation and ulceration of the laryngeal lining, often after radiation, chemotherapy, infection, or irritation.

### **Laryngeal Nerve**

laryngeal nerve refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Laryngeal Obstruction**

A clinical condition or finding involving laryngeal obstruction. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Laryngeal Web**

A laryngeal web is a thin membrane across part of the airway, usually congenital or acquired after injury, causing hoarseness or airway narrowing.

### **Larynx Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving larynx disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Larynx Muscle**

larynx muscle refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related

disease or injury.

### **Larynx Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving larynx neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Laser Capture Microdissection**

A biological or biochemical term involving laser capture microdissection. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Laser Surgery**

laser surgery is used in relation to laser surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Laser Therapy**

laser therapy is used in relation to laser therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Lassa Virus**

lassa virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Lassitude**

A clinical condition or finding involving lassitude. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Latanoprost**

Latanoprost is a prostaglandin F2-alpha analogue eye drop that increases uveoscleral outflow and lowers intraocular pressure in glaucoma or ocular hypertension; iris pigmentation and eyelash growth may occur.

### **Late Endosome**

A late endosome is a membrane-bound cell compartment that receives cargo from early endosomes and matures toward lysosomal degradation.

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### **Latent Syphilis**

Latent syphilis is syphilis infection without current symptoms, identified by testing and classified by duration to guide treatment and follow-up.

### **Lateral Meniscus**

The lateral meniscus is a crescent-shaped cartilage pad on the outer side of the knee that distributes load and stabilizes movement.

### **Lateral Sclerosis**

Lateral sclerosis describes hardening or degeneration involving a lateral structure, often referring to spinal motor pathways in motor-neuron disease.

### **Lateral Ventricle**

A lateral ventricle is one of the paired cerebrospinal-fluid-filled cavities within a cerebral hemisphere.

### **Lathyrism**

A clinical condition or finding involving lathyrism. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lauric Acid**

lauric acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lauroleic Acid**

lauroleic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lavage Fluid**

lavage fluid is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

### **Lead**

Lead is a toxic heavy metal that can injure the nervous system, blood, kidneys, and development, especially in children.

### **Learning Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving learning disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lecithin**

A biological or biochemical term involving lecithin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leclercia**

leclercia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Leclercia Adecarboxylata**

leclercia adecarboxylata is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Lectin**

A biological or biochemical term involving lectin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **LED Therapy**

LED therapy is used in relation to led therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Leech Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to leech therapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Leeche**

A biomedical term referring to leeches; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leflunomide**

Leflunomide is a disease-modifying antirheumatic



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drug that inhibits dihydroorotate dehydrogenase and lymphocyte proliferation; it treats rheumatoid or psoriatic arthritis but can cause hepatotoxicity, cytopenias, hypertension, and fetal harm.

### **Left Kidney**

The left kidney filters blood, regulates fluid and electrolytes, produces urine and hormones, and lies on the left side of the abdomen.

### **Left Lung**

The left lung exchanges oxygen and carbon dioxide and has two lobes because the heart occupies part of the left chest.

### **Leg**

leg refers to leg, an anatomical or physiologic concept used to describe a body structure, process, or function.

### **Legionella**

legionella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Legionella Longbeachae**

legionella longbeachae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Legionellosis**

A biological or biochemical term involving legionellosis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leifsonia**

A biomedical term referring to leifsonia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leifsonia Aquatica**

A biomedical term referring to leifsonia aquatica; its classification, distinguishing features, and med-

ical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leigh Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving leigh disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Leiomyomatosis**

Leiomyomatosis is development of multiple benign smooth-muscle tumors or proliferations, which may affect the uterus, skin, lungs, or other sites.

### **Leishmania**

leishmania is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Leishmania Chagasi**

leishmania chagasi is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Leishmania Major**

leishmania major is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Leishmania Mexicana**

leishmania mexicana is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Leishmania Tropica**

leishmania tropica is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Lelliottia Amnigena**

A medical term referring to lelliottia amnigena. Its

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clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leminorella Grimontii**

A biomedical term referring to leminorella grimontii; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leminorella Richardii**

A biomedical term referring to leminorella richardii; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Lenalidomide**

Lenalidomide is an immunomodulatory anticancer drug used for multiple myeloma and selected myelodysplastic or lymphoma disorders; myelosuppression, thrombosis, infection, and severe teratogenicity are important risks.

### **Lenograstim**

A medical term referring to lenograstim. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lens Coloboma**

A lens coloboma is a congenital segmental defect or notch in the eye lens caused by incomplete development.

### **Lens Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving lens disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lens Dislocation**

A clinical condition or finding involving lens dislocation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lens Subluxation**

A clinical condition or finding involving lens subluxation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lente Insulin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called lente insulin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Lentiform Nucleus**

The lentiform nucleus is a basal-ganglia structure composed of the putamen and globus pallidus and involved in motor control.

### **Lentigo**

A lentigo is a sharply defined flat brown skin spot caused by increased melanocytes or pigment and may be benign or, rarely, atypical.

### **Lentinan**

Lentinan is a beta-glucan from shiitake mushrooms studied as an immune modulator and adjunctive cancer treatment.

### **LEOPARD Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving leopard syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lepidoptera**

A medical term referring to lepidoptera. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lepirudin**

Lepirudin is a direct thrombin inhibitor formerly used as an anticoagulant in heparin-induced thrombocytopenia; bleeding and kidney clearance are important considerations.

### **Leptin Receptor**

leptin receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Leptomeningeal Sarcoma**

A neoplasm involving leptomeningeal sarcoma. Di-

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agnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Leptospira**

A medical term referring to leptospira. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leptospiraceae**

A medical term referring to leptospiraceae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leptotrichia**

A medical term referring to leptotrichia. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leridistim**

Leridistim is an investigational hematopoietic growth factor designed to stimulate production of neutrophils and other blood cells.

### **Lerisetron**

Lerisetron is an investigational serotonin 5-HT<sub>3</sub> receptor antagonist studied to prevent nausea and vomiting.

### **Lesion Identification**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to lesion identification. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Less Than**

Less than indicates a value below a stated amount or threshold, such as a laboratory reference limit, dose, age, or measurement.

### **Lestaurtinib**

A medical term referring to lestaurtinib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lethal Injection**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to lethal injection; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Lethargy**

Lethargy is reduced energy, alertness, or responsiveness; it may result from sleep loss, infection, metabolic disease, medicines, depression, or neurologic illness, and sudden marked lethargy requires urgent assessment.

### **Letrozole**

Letrozole is an aromatase inhibitor that lowers oestrogen production and is used mainly for hormone-receptor-positive breast cancer and ovulation induction; hot flushes, arthralgia, bone loss, and fetal harm are important considerations.

### **Leucine**

A biological or biochemical term involving leucine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leucine Zipper**

A biological or biochemical term involving leucine zipper. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leuconostoc**

A biomedical term referring to leuconostoc; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leuconostoc Citreum**

A biomedical term referring to leuconostoc citreum; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leuconostoc Lactis**

A biomedical term referring to leuconostoc lactis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Leuconostoc Mesenteroides**

A biomedical term referring to leuconostoc mesenteroides; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or

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biologic context.

### **Leuconostocaceae**

leuconostocaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Leucovorin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called leucovorin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Leucovorin Calcium**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called leucovorin calcium. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Leukapheresis**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to leukapheresis; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Leukoaraiosis**

Leukoaraiosis describes white-matter changes seen on brain imaging, commonly associated with small-vessel disease, aging, hypertension, and vascular risk.

### **Leukocyte**

White blood cell; component of the immune system responsible for fighting infection and disease. Types include neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Leukocyte Differentiation**

A biological or biochemical term involving leukocyte differentiation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leukocyte Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving leukocyte disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Leukocyte Elastase**

Leukocyte elastase is a proteolytic enzyme released mainly by neutrophils that can destroy microbes but also injure tissue during excessive inflammation.

### **Leukocyte Trafficking**

Leukocyte trafficking is movement of white blood cells through blood and tissues, directed by adhesion molecules and chemical signals during immune surveillance or inflammation.

### **Leukocyte Transfusion**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to leukocyte transfusion; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Leukodystrophy**

A clinical condition or finding involving leukodystrophy. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Leukoencephalopathy**

Leukoencephalopathy is disease of the brain's white matter caused by inherited, infectious, toxic, vascular, metabolic, inflammatory, or other processes.

### **Leukostasis**

A clinical condition or finding involving leukostasis. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Leukotriene**

A leukotriene is an inflammatory lipid mediator made from arachidonic acid that contributes to bronchoconstriction, mucus, vascular leak, and immune-cell recruitment.

### **Leukotriene Degradation**

A biological or biochemical term involving

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leukotriene degradation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leukotriene Receptor**

leukotriene receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Leuprolide**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called leuprolide. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Leuprolide Acetate**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called leuprolide acetate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Levalbuterol**

Levalbuterol is an inhaled short-acting beta-2 agonist that relaxes airway smooth muscle and relieves bronchospasm.

### **Levamisole**

Levamisole is an antiparasitic and immune-modulating drug used selectively; serious low white-cell counts and vasculitic reactions can occur.

### **Levetiracetam**

Levetiracetam is a broad-spectrum antiseizure medicine that binds synaptic vesicle protein SV2A; it treats focal and generalized seizures and may cause somnolence, dizziness, or behavioral and mood changes.

### **Levobunolol**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called levobunolol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Levocardia**

Levocardia is a normal left-sided position of the heart; it may occur with normal organ arrangement or with other congenital laterality abnormalities.

### **Levocarnitine**

Levocarnitine is the biologically active form of carnitine used to treat selected carnitine deficiencies and help transport fatty acids into mitochondria.

### **Levodopa**

Levodopa is a dopamine precursor that crosses the blood–brain barrier and is converted to dopamine, usually with carbidopa or benserazide, to treat Parkinson disease; dyskinesias, hallucinations, nausea, and motor fluctuations can develop.

### **Levofloxacin**

Levofloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; tendon injury, peripheral neuropathy, QT prolongation, dysglycaemia, and central-nervous-system effects are important class risks.

### **Levoleucovorin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called levoleucovorin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Levoleucovorin Calcium**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called levoleucovorin calcium. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Levonorgestrel**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called levonorgestrel. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Levorphanol**

Levorphanol is a potent opioid analgesic that can relieve severe pain but also cause sedation, depen-

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dence, and respiratory depression.

### **Lewy Body**

A Lewy body is an abnormal neuronal inclusion containing alpha-synuclein, characteristic of Parkinson disease and Lewy-body dementia.

### **Lexatumumab**

A medical term referring to lexatumumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leydig Cell**

Leydig cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Liarozole**

A medical term referring to liarozole. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lice Infestation**

A biomedical term referring to lice infestation; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Lidocaine**

Lidocaine is a local anaesthetic that blocks voltage-gated sodium channels and, intravenously, can treat selected ventricular arrhythmias; excessive exposure may cause seizures, hypotension, arrhythmia, or cardiac arrest.

### **Ligase**

A biological or biochemical term involving ligase. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Light Coagulation**

A biological or biochemical term involving light coagulation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Light Cycle**

A medical term referring to light cycle. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Light Microscope**

light microscope is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Light Microscopy**

light microscopy is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Light Scattering**

light scattering is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Lignan**

A biological or biochemical term involving lignan. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lignin**

A biological or biochemical term involving lignin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lignoceric Acid**

lignoceric acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Limb**

A limb is an arm or leg and its associated bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, and soft tissues.



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## **Limb Bud**

A limb bud is an embryonic outgrowth that develops into an arm or leg through coordinated signaling, growth, and tissue differentiation.

## **Limb Development**

Limb development is embryonic formation and growth of the bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, and skin of the arms and legs.

## **Limb Fracture**

A clinical condition or finding involving limb fracture. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Limb Girdle**

A limb girdle is the skeletal connection of a limb to the trunk, such as the shoulder or pelvic girdle.

## **Limb Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving limb injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Limb Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving limb pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Limb Prosthesis**

A limb prosthesis is an artificial device replacing part or all of an arm or leg to restore mobility, function, appearance, or independence.

## **Limbus Corneae**

The corneal limbus is the circular border where the transparent cornea meets the white sclera and conjunctiva, containing stem cells important for corneal repair.

## **Linagliptin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called linagliptin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Lincomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called lincomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Lindane**

Lindane is an organochlorine insecticide formerly used for lice or scabies; neurotoxicity and environmental persistence limit its use.

## **Lined Canister**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving lined canister. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Linezolid**

Linezolid is an oxazolidinone antibiotic that blocks formation of the bacterial 70S initiation complex and treats resistant Gram-positive infections; thrombocytopenia, neuropathy, lactic acidosis, and serotonin interactions require caution.

## **Lingual Thyroid**

A lingual thyroid is thyroid tissue at the base of the tongue caused by failure of normal thyroid descent and may obstruct swallowing or breathing or cause hypothyroidism.

## **Lingual Tonsil**

The lingual tonsil is lymphoid tissue at the base of the tongue that contributes to immune surveillance of the throat.

## **Liniment**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving liniment. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Linkage Disequilibrium**

A medical term referring to linkage disequilibrium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **Linoleic Acid**

linoleic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Linolenic Acid**

linolenic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Linsitinib**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called linsitinib. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Lintuzumab**

A medical term referring to lintuzumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lip**

The lips are mobile folds of skin and mucosa containing muscle, blood vessels, and sensory nerves; they form the oral seal and assist speech, facial expression, feeding, and swallowing.

### **Lip Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving lip disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lip Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving lip infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Lip Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving lip neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Lipemic Index**

lipemic index is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference

range.

### **Lipid Bilayer**

lipid bilayer is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Binding**

lipid binding is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Lipid Disorder**

lipid disorder is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Droplet**

lipid droplet is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Metabolism**

lipid metabolism is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Peroxidation**

lipid peroxidation is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Peroxide**

lipid peroxide is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lipid Transport**

lipid transport is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

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## Lipidomics

lipidomics is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## Lipoblastoma

A medical term referring to lipoblastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Lipogranulomatosis

Lipogranulomatosis is inflammation caused by lipid accumulation and granuloma formation, which may occur in skin, soft tissue, or internal organs.

## Lipoidosis

Lipoidosis is a disorder involving abnormal accumulation of lipids in cells or tissues, often from inherited storage disease or another metabolic problem.

## Lipomatous Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving lipomatous neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Lipophagy

A medical term referring to lipophagy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Lipophilicity

A medical term referring to lipophilicity. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Lipopolysaccharide

Lipopolysaccharide is the outer-membrane endotoxin of Gram-negative bacteria, consisting of lipid A, core polysaccharide, and O antigen; circulating lipid A can trigger cytokine release, fever, shock, and disseminated inflammation.

## Liposome

A medical term referring to liposome. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Liquid Chromatography

liquid chromatography is a diagnostic test, specimen,

imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

## Liraglutide

A medical term referring to liraglutide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Lisch Nodule

A Lisch nodule is a harmless pigmented hamartoma of the iris, commonly associated with neurofibromatosis type 1.

## Lisinopril

Lisinopril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension, heart failure, and kidney protection in some diabetes; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

## Listeria

listeria is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### Synonyms:

Infection Listeria (Listeria)

## Listeria Grayi

listeria grayi is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

## Listeria Innocua

listeria innocua is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

## Listeria Ivanovii

listeria ivanovii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather

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than colonization.

### **Listeria Seeligeri**

*listeria seeligeri* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Listeria Welshimeri**

*listeria welshimeri* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Lithium**

Lithium is a mood stabilizer used mainly for bipolar disorder and selected augmentation treatment; its narrow therapeutic range requires monitoring for tremor, thyroid or renal dysfunction, dehydration, drug interactions, and toxicity.

### **Lithium Carbonate**

A medical term referring to lithium carbonate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Little's Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving little's disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Live Birth**

A live birth is delivery of an infant showing signs of life such as breathing, heartbeat, or movement, regardless of gestational age.

### **Livedo Racemosa**

A medical term referring to livedo racemosa. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Liver Circulation**

A biological or biochemical term involving liver circulation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Liver Damage**

Liver damage is injury or loss of liver-cell function caused by infection, alcohol, medicines, toxins, fatty disease, autoimmune disease, or other processes.

### **Liver Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving liver disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Liver Dysfunction**

A biological or biochemical term involving liver dysfunction. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Liver Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving liver infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Liver Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving liver neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Liver Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving liver pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Liver Regeneration**

liver regeneration is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Lobaplatin**

Lobaplatin is a platinum-based antineoplastic drug used in some countries and studied for its ability to damage cancer-cell DNA.

### **Lobe**

A lobe is a distinct subdivision of an organ or structure, such as a lung, liver, brain, thyroid, or gland.

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### **Lobeline**

Lobeline is a plant alkaloid that affects nicotinic receptors and has been studied for respiratory, neurologic, and smoking-cessation effects.

### **Lobstein Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving lobstein disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lobucavir**

A medical term referring to lobucavir. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lobular Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving lobular carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Lobule**

A lobule is a small subdivision of an organ or tissue, such as a liver lobule, lung lobule, or breast lobule.

### **Local**

Local means limited to a particular site or region rather than involving the whole body.

### **Local Therapy**

local therapy is used in relation to local therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Localized Edema**

A clinical condition or finding involving localized edema. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Localized Scleroderma**

A medical term referring to localized scleroderma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Locus Coeruleus**

The locus coeruleus is a brainstem nucleus whose noradrenaline-producing neurons influence arousal,

attention, stress, sleep, and pain.

### **Lod Score**

lod score is a diagnostic test, specimen, imaging method, score, instrument, or measurement used to answer a clinical or laboratory question; results must be interpreted with the method and reference range.

### **Loiasis**

Loiasis is infection with the filarial worm *Loa loa*, transmitted by deerflies and sometimes causing transient eye-worm migration and localized swelling.

### **Lometrexol**

Lometrexol is an investigational antifolate that inhibits glycinamide ribonucleotide transformylase and has been studied as an anticancer agent.

### **Lomustine**

A medical term referring to lomustine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lonafarnib**

A medical term referring to lonafarnib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Longevity**

Longevity is length of life or survival and is influenced by biology, disease, behavior, environment, social conditions, and healthcare.

### **Longitudinal Studies**

Longitudinal studies follow participants or measurements over time to examine change, incidence, exposures, outcomes, and temporal relationships.

### **Long-Term Potentiation**

A biological or biochemical term involving long-term potentiation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lontucirev**

Lontucirev is an investigational targeted anticancer antibody or drug studied for effects on tumor-

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associated targets.

### **Loperamide**

Loperamide is a peripherally acting opioid-receptor agonist that slows intestinal motility and reduces diarrhoea; it should be avoided in bloody or febrile diarrhoea and excessive doses can cause severe cardiac arrhythmias.

### **Loperamide Hydrochloride**

A medical term referring to loperamide hydrochloride. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lopinavir**

A medical term referring to lopinavir. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lorazepam**

A medical term referring to lorazepam. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lorenzo's Oil**

Lorenzo's oil is a mixture of fatty acids used experimentally to reduce very-long-chain fatty acids in adrenoleukodystrophy, with benefit depending on disease stage and context.

### **Losartan**

A medical term referring to losartan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Losartan Potassium**

A medical term referring to losartan potassium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Losoxantrone**

Losoxantrone is an investigational anthracenedione-like antineoplastic compound that interferes with DNA and cancer-cell growth.

### **Loss Of Heterozygosity**

A medical term referring to loss of heterozygosity. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which

it is used.

### **Loteprednol Etabonate**

A medical term referring to loteprednol etabonate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Louse**

A biomedical term referring to louse; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Lovastatin**

A medical term referring to lovastatin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Low Grade**

Low grade describes a lesion or disease with relatively less aggressive microscopic features or behavior, though prognosis depends on the specific condition.

### **Lower Extremity**

The lower extremity is the hip, thigh, knee, leg, ankle, and foot, including their bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, and skin.

### **Lubiprostone**

A medical term referring to lubiprostone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lubricant**

A medical term referring to lubricant. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lucanthone**

Lucanthone is an older antiparasitic and investigational antineoplastic compound with effects on parasite or tumor-cell DNA metabolism.

### **Luciferase**

A medical term referring to luciferase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### **Lugol's Solution**

A biological or biochemical term involving lugol's solution. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lumbar Plexus**

The lumbar plexus is a network of nerves from the upper lumbar spinal roots that supplies the lower abdomen, pelvis, and parts of the thigh and leg.

### **Lumbar Region**

A biological or biochemical term involving lumbar region. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lumbosacral Region**

A biological or biochemical term involving lumbosacral region. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Luminescence**

Luminescence is emission of light from a substance through a process other than high-temperature incandescence, such as fluorescence or chemiluminescence.

### **Luminescence Type**

Luminescence type identifies the mechanism by which a material emits light, such as fluorescence, phosphorescence, bioluminescence, or chemiluminescence.

### **Lung Cyst**

A lung cyst is a round air- or fluid-containing space in lung tissue, caused by developmental disease, infection, emphysema, inflammation, or another disorder.

### **Lung Development**

Lung development is embryonic and postnatal formation and maturation of airways, alveoli, blood vessels, and gas-exchange capacity.

### **Lung Fibroma**

A lung fibroma is a usually benign fibrous tumor in

or around lung tissue, often found incidentally and assessed by imaging or biopsy when needed.

### **Lung Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving lung injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lung Lavage**

Lung lavage is washing or flushing of the airways or lungs with fluid, used in selected conditions such as pulmonary alveolar proteinosis or sampling.

### **Lung Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving lung neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Lurtotecan**

Lurtotecan is an investigational topoisomerase-I inhibitor studied for anticancer activity by interfering with DNA replication and repair.

### **Luteal Cell**

luteal cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Luteinization**

A biological or biochemical term involving luteinization. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Luteolin**

A medical term referring to luteolin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Luteolysis**

A medical term referring to luteolysis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Luteoma**

A medical term referring to luteoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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## **Lyase**

A medical term referring to lyase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Lycopene**

A medical term referring to lycopene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Lymph Leakage**

Lymph leakage is escape of lymphatic fluid after injury, surgery, or obstruction and may cause swelling, fluid collections, or chylous drainage.

## **Lymph Node**

A lymph node is a small immune organ that filters lymph and helps activate immune responses to infection, inflammation, or abnormal cells.

## **Lymphangiogenesis**

lymphangiogenesis is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

## **Lymphangiomyoma**

Lymphangiomyoma is a benign proliferation of lymphatic-type smooth-muscle cells, usually discussed in relation to lymphangioleiomyomatosis.

## **Lymphangiosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving lymphangiosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## **Lymphatic Basin**

A lymphatic basin is the group of lymph nodes and drainage pathways receiving lymph from a defined body region.

## **Lymphatic Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving lymphatic disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Lymphatic Mapping**

A clinical condition or finding involving lymphatic mapping. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Lymphatic Tissue**

Lymphatic tissue contains immune cells and structures that filter lymph, trap antigens, and coordinate immune defense.

## **Lymphatic Vessel**

A lymphatic vessel transports lymph from tissues through lymph nodes and eventually returns fluid to the bloodstream.

## **Lymphoblast**

A lymphoblast is an immature lymphoid precursor that normally develops into a B or T lymphocyte; uncontrolled accumulation occurs in acute lymphoblastic leukemia.

## **Lymphoblast Count**

lymphoblast count is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

## **Lymphocele**

A lymphocele is a collection of lymphatic fluid caused by disruption or blockage of lymph vessels, often after surgery or transplantation.

## **Lymphocyte Activation**

A clinical condition or finding involving lymphocyte activation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Lymphocyte Count**

lymphocyte count is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

## **Lymphocyte Proliferation**

A clinical condition or finding involving lymphocyte

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proliferation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lymphocytic Leukemia**

A neoplasm involving lymphocytic leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Lymphocytoma Cutis**

Lymphocytoma cutis is a benign skin lymphoid proliferation presenting as red or violaceous plaques or nodules and sometimes associated with infection or immune stimulation.

### **Lymphomatoid Papulosis**

A neoplasm involving lymphomatoid papulosis. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Lymphopenia**

Lymphopenia is an abnormally low number of lymphocytes, caused by infection, medicines, immune disease, malnutrition, marrow disorders, or other conditions.

### **Lymphoproliferative Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving lymphoproliferative disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lysine**

A medical term referring to lysine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lysinibacillus**

lysinibacillus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Lysogeny**

A medical term referring to lysogeny. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Lysophagy**

A biochemical process or molecule involving lysophagy. Its role depends on its structure, pathway, and physiological context.

### **Lysophosphatidylcholine**

A biochemical process or molecule involving lysophosphatidylcholine. Its role depends on its structure, pathway, and physiological context.

### **Lysophospholipids**

lysophospholipids is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Lysozyme Test**

lysozyme test is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Lyssavirus**

lyssavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Lytic Lesion**

A biological or biochemical term involving lytic lesion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Leg Pain**

A clinical condition involving leg Pain; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Leg Swelling**

Enlargement or puffiness of one or both legs caused by fluid retention, venous disease, injury, infection, inflammation, or a blood clot.

### **Low White Blood Cell Count**

A reduced number of white blood cells, which can

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increase susceptibility to infection and may result from medicines, infection, autoimmune disease, nutritional deficiency, or bone marrow disorders.

### **Loss Of Smell (Anosmia)**

Partial or complete inability to detect odors, commonly caused by nasal obstruction, infection, inflammation, head injury, neurologic disease, or certain medicines.

### **Low Blood Oxygen (Hypoxemia)**

An abnormally low oxygen level in arterial blood, usually related to lung disease, impaired breathing, circulation problems, or reduced oxygen availability.

### **Low Potassium (Hypokalemia)**

An abnormally low potassium level in the blood, which can cause weakness, cramps, abnormal heart rhythms, or paralysis and may result from losses, medicines, or hormonal disorders.

### **Lymphocytosis (High Lymphocyte Count)**

An increased number of lymphocytes in the blood, often associated with infection, inflammation, or a lymphoproliferative disorder.

### **Lactase Deficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Lactose intolerance*.

### **Lactation Mastitis**

Alternate index label; see *Mastitis*.

### **Lateral Elbow Tendinopathy**

Alternate index label; see *Tennis elbow*.

### **Lateral Epicondylitis**

Alternate index label; see *Tennis elbow*.

### **Lateral Epicondylosis**

Alternate index label; see *Tennis elbow*.

### **LCIS**

Alternate index label; see *Lobular carcinoma in situ (LCIS)*.

### **Leg Fracture**

Alternate index label; see *Broken leg*.

### **Lentigines, Solar**

Alternate index label; see *Age spots (liver spots)*.

### **Leukemia, Acute Lymphocytic**

Alternate index label; see *Acute lymphocytic leukemia*.

### **Leukemia, Acute Myelogenous**

Alternate index label; see *Acute myelogenous leukemia*.

### **Leukemia, Chronic Lymphocytic**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic lymphocytic leukemia*.

### **Leukemia, Chronic Myelogenous**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic myelogenous leukemia*.

### **Leukemia, General**

Alternate index label; see *Leukemia*.

### **Leukemia, Hairy Cell**

Alternate index label; see *Hairy cell leukemia*.

### **Lice, Body**

Alternate index label; see *Body lice*.

### **Lichen Planus, Oral**

Alternate index label; see *Oral lichen planus*.

### **Lipodystrophy, Intestinal**

Alternate index label; see *Whipple's disease*.

### **Liver Failure, Acute**

Alternate index label; see *Acute liver failure*.

### **Liver Spots**

Liver spots are flat brown areas of sun-related pigmentation, also called solar lentigines, and are not caused by liver disease.

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### **Liver, Enlarged**

Alternate index label; see *Enlarged liver*.

### **Lockjaw**

Alternate index label; see *Tetanus*.

### **Loss Of Bladder Control**

Alternate index label; see *Urinary incontinence*.

### **Lou Gehrig's Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS)*.

### **Low Blood Sugar**

Low blood sugar, or hypoglycemia, occurs when circulating glucose is insufficient for normal brain and body function, causing sweating, tremor, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

### **Low Body Temperature**

Alternate index label; see *Hypothermia*.

### **Low Platelet Count**

Alternate index label; see *Thrombocytopenia*.

### **Low Testosterone**

Alternate index label; see *Male hypogonadism*.

### **Low-Flow Priapism**

Alternate index label; see *Priapism*.

### **Lung Collapse**

Alternate index label; see *Atelectasis*; see also *Pneumothorax*.

### **Lung Disease, Interstitial**

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial lung disease*.

### **Lymph Nodes, Swollen**

Alternate index label; see *Swollen lymph nodes*.

### **Lymphadenitis, Mesenteric**

Alternate index label; see *Mesenteric lymphadenitis*.

### **Lymphoma, Hodgkin**

Alternate index label; see *Hodgkin lymphoma (Hodgkin disease)*.

### **Lymphoma, Non-Hodgkin**

Alternate index label; see *Non-Hodgkin lymphoma*.

### **Lymphoplasmacytic Lymphoma**

Alternate index label; see *Waldenstrom macroglobulinemia*.

### **Labyrinthitis - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to labyrinthitis - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Laceration - Sutures Or Staples - At Home**

Laceration - sutures or staples - at home addresses care related to laceration - sutures or staples - at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Lacerations - Liquid Bandage**

A biological or biochemical term involving lacerations - liquid bandage. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Lacquer Poisoning**

Lacquer poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to lacquer poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Lacrimal Gland Tumor**

A biomedical term referring to lacrimal gland tumor; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Lactate Dehydrogenase Test**

Lactate dehydrogenase test examines lactate dehydrogenase test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference

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range, and clinical question.

### **Lactic Acid Test**

Lactic acid test examines lactic acid test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lactose Tolerance Tests**

Lactose tolerance tests examines lactose tolerance tests; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lamellar Ichthyosis**

Lamellar ichthyosis is an inherited scaling disorder present from birth, causing widespread large dark scales, dry skin, and impaired heat or water regulation.

### **Language Disorders In Children**

A clinical finding or condition involving language Disorders In Children; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Lanolin Poisoning**

Lanolin poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to lanolin poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Laparoscopic Gallbladder Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laparoscopic gallbladder removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Laparoscopic Gastric Banding**

A medical term referring to laparoscopic gastric banding. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Laparoscopic Gastric Banding - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laparoscopic gastric banding - dis-

charge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Laparoscopic Spleen Removal In Adults - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laparoscopic spleen removal in adults - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Large Bowel Resection**

Large bowel resection examines large bowel resection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Large Bowel Resection - Discharge**

Large bowel resection - discharge examines large bowel resection - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Large For Gestational Age (LGA)**

A biological or biochemical term involving large for gestational age (lga). Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Laryngoscopy And Nasolaryngoscopy**

A medical term referring to laryngoscopy and nasolaryngoscopy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Laser Photocoagulation - Eye**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving laser photocoagulation - eye. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Laser Surgery For The Skin**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laser surgery for the skin; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.



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### **Laser Therapy For Cancer**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to laser therapy for cancer; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **LASIK Eye Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to lasik eye surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Lasik Eye Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to lasik eye surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Lateral Traction**

Lateral traction examines lateral traction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Latex Agglutination Test**

Latex agglutination test examines latex agglutination test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Latex Allergies - For Hospital Patients**

Latex allergy can cause contact dermatitis, hives, wheeze, or anaphylaxis; hospitals reduce risk with latex-free supplies and clear documentation of the allergy.

### **Lavender Oil**

Lavender oil is an aromatic essential oil used in fragrances and complementary products; ingestion, skin reactions, and interactions are possible.

### **Laxative Overdose**

Laxative overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to laxative overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **LDH Isoenzyme Blood Test**

LDH isoenzyme blood test examines ldh isoenzyme blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **LDL Test**

LDL test examines ldl test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lead - Nutritional Considerations**

Lead - nutritional considerations involves toxic or environmental exposure to lead - nutritional considerations; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Lead And Tap Water**

Lead and tap water involves toxic or environmental exposure to lead and tap water; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Lead Levels - Blood**

Lead levels - blood involves toxic or environmental exposure to lead levels - blood; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Learn About Gluten-Free Diets**

Learn about gluten-free diets addresses care related to learn about gluten-free diets, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Learn To Love Exercise**

Learn to love exercise addresses care related to learn to love exercise, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Learn To Manage Stress**

Learn to manage stress addresses care related to learn to manage stress, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss

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with a clinician.

### **Learn To Manage Your Anger**

Learn to manage your anger addresses care related to learn to manage your anger, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Learning About Depression**

Learning about depression addresses care related to learning about depression, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Learning About Ventilators**

A ventilator supports or replaces breathing by delivering controlled airflow and oxygen; understanding alarms, tubes, sedation, and weaning helps families participate in care.

### **Leaving The Hospital - Your Discharge Plan**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to leaving the hospital - your discharge plan; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Left Heart Catheterization**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving left heart catheterization. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Left Heart Ventricular Angiography**

Left heart ventricular angiography examines left heart ventricular angiography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Leg Amputation - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to leg amputation - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Leg CT Scan**

Leg CT scan examines leg ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Leg Lengthening And Shortening**

A medical term referring to leg lengthening and shortening. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Leg MRI Scan**

Leg MRI scan examines leg mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Leg Or Foot Amputation**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving leg or foot amputation. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Leg Or Foot Amputation - Dressing Change**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving leg or foot amputation - dressing change. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Lepromin Skin Test**

Lepromin skin test examines lepromin skin test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lesch-Nyhan Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving lesch-Nyhan Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Leucine Aminopeptidase - Urine**

A biochemical laboratory test related to leucine aminopeptidase - urine. Results are interpreted with the specimen, method, reference range, and clinical findings.

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## **Leukemia - Resources**

Leukemia - resources addresses care related to leukemia - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Leukocyte Esterase Urine Test**

Leukocyte esterase urine test examines leukocyte esterase urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Leydig Cell Testicular Tumor**

Leydig cell testicular tumor examines leydig cell testicular tumor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **LH Response To GnRH Blood Test**

LH response to GnRH blood test examines lh response to gnrh blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lichenified**

Lichenified skin is thickened and leathery from chronic rubbing or scratching, commonly occurring in longstanding eczema or itch disorders.

## **Life After Weight-Loss Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to life after weight-loss surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Lifting And Bending The Right Way**

Safe lifting and bending use planning, a stable base, load close to the body, hip and knee movement, and assistance for heavy or awkward objects.

## **Lighter Fluid Poisoning**

Lighter fluid poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to lighter fluid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Lily Of The Valley Poisoning**

Lily of the valley poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to lily of the valley poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Limb Plethysmography**

Limb plethysmography examines limb plethysmography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophies**

Limb-girdle muscular dystrophies are inherited muscle diseases causing progressive weakness predominantly around the hips and shoulders, with variable cardiac and respiratory involvement.

## **Limited Range Of Motion**

A biological or biochemical term involving limited range of motion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## **Lip Moisturizer Poisoning**

Lip moisturizer poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to lip moisturizer poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Lipase Test**

A lipase test measures a pancreatic digestive enzyme in blood and supports evaluation of acute pancreatitis and selected pancreatic or gastrointestinal disorders.

## **Lipid Profile Test**

Lipid profile test examines lipid profile test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Liquid Incense**

Liquid Incense involves toxic or environmental exposure to liquid incense; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

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### **Liquid Medication Administration**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called liquid medication administration. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Liquid Nitrogen**

Liquid nitrogen is extremely cold nitrogen used to freeze tissue in cryotherapy; contact can cause frostbite and its gas can displace oxygen.

### **Liver Cancer - Hepatocellular Carcinoma**

Liver cancer - hepatocellular carcinoma refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Liver Disease - Resources**

Liver disease - resources addresses care related to liver disease - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Liver Metastases**

Liver metastases are cancer deposits that spread to the liver from another primary tumor and may cause no symptoms or produce pain, weight loss, or liver dysfunction.

### **Liver Scan**

Liver scan examines liver scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Living With A Chronic Illness - Dealing With Feelings**

Living with a chronic illness - dealing with feelings addresses care related to living with a chronic illness - dealing with feelings, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With A Chronic Illness - Reaching Out To Others**

Living with a chronic illness - reaching out to oth-

ers addresses care related to living with a chronic illness - reaching out to others, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Endometriosis**

Living with endometriosis addresses care related to living with endometriosis, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Hearing Loss**

Living with hearing loss addresses care related to living with hearing loss, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Heart Disease And Angina**

Living with heart disease and angina addresses care related to living with heart disease and angina, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Uterine Fibroids**

Living with uterine fibroids addresses care related to living with uterine fibroids, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Vision Loss**

Living with vision loss addresses care related to living with vision loss, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Living With Your Ileostomy**

Living with your ileostomy addresses care related to living with your ileostomy, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Lomotil Overdose**

Lomotil overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to lomotil overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine ur-

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gency and treatment.

### **Long Bones**

Long bones concerns long bones, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Long-Term Complications Of Diabetes**

A clinical condition or finding involving long-term complications of diabetes. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Lordosis - Lumbar**

Lumbar lordosis is the inward curve of the lower spine; excessive or reduced curvature may be postural, structural, degenerative, or related to pain.

### **Losing Weight After Pregnancy**

Postpartum weight loss should be gradual and compatible with recovery, nutrition, sleep, breastfeeding needs, and medical conditions rather than rapid restrictive dieting.

### **Loss Of A Child - Resources**

Loss of a child - resources addresses care related to loss of a child - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Loss Of A Spouse - Resources**

Loss of a spouse - resources addresses care related to loss of a spouse - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Loss Of Brain Function - Liver Disease**

Loss of brain function - liver disease examines loss of brain function - liver disease; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Low Back Pain - Acute**

A clinical condition involving low Back Pain - Acute; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complica-

tions guide diagnosis and management.

### **Low Back Pain - Chronic**

A clinical condition involving low Back Pain - Chronic; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Low Blood Potassium**

Low blood potassium, or hypokalemia, can cause weakness, cramps, constipation, abnormal heart rhythms, or paralysis and may result from losses, medicines, or hormonal disease.

### **Low Blood Pressure**

Low blood pressure can cause dizziness, fainting, weakness, or shock and may result from dehydration, medicines, bleeding, infection, heart disease, or autonomic dysfunction.

### **Low Blood Sodium**

Low blood sodium, or hyponatremia, reflects excess water relative to sodium and can cause headache, confusion, seizures, or coma when severe or rapidly developing.

### **Low Blood Sugar - Newborns**

Low blood sugar in a newborn can cause jitteriness, poor feeding, lethargy, apnea, or seizures and is more likely with prematurity, growth problems, maternal diabetes, or illness.

### **Low Blood Sugar - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to low blood sugar - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Low Calcium Level - Infants**

Low calcium level - infants examines low calcium level - infants; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Low Nasal Bridge**

A low nasal bridge is reduced height of the nasal

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root and may be a normal familial feature or part of a congenital, genetic, or developmental syndrome.

### **Low White Blood Cell Count And Cancer**

Low white blood cell count and cancer examines low white blood cell count and cancer; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Low-Fiber Diet**

Low-fiber diet addresses care related to low-fiber diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Low-Salt Diet**

Low-salt diet addresses care related to low-salt diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Low-Set Ears And Pinna Abnormalities**

Low-set ears and pinna abnormalities concerns low-set ears and pinna abnormalities, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Lower Esophageal Ring**

Lower esophageal ring concerns lower esophageal ring, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Lower-Calorie Choices For Alcoholic Drinks**

Lower-calorie choices for alcoholic drinks addresses care related to lower-calorie choices for alcoholic drinks, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Lumbar MRI Scan**

Lumbar MRI scan examines lumbar mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lumbar Spine CT Scan**

Lumbar spine CT scan examines lumbar spine ct

scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lumbosacral Spine CT**

Lumbosacral spine CT examines lumbosacral spine ct; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lumbosacral Spine X-Ray**

Lumbosacral spine x-ray examines lumbosacral spine x-ray; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lump In The Abdomen**

An abdominal lump may be a hernia, enlarged organ, cyst, stool, inflammation, or tumor; pain, vomiting, fever, growth, or a pulsatile mass requires prompt assessment.

### **Lung Cancer - Small Cell**

Lung cancer - small cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Lung Diffusion Testing**

Lung diffusion testing examines lung diffusion testing; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Lung Disease - Resources**

Lung disease - resources addresses care related to lung disease - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Lung Gallium Scan**

Lung gallium scan examines lung gallium scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.



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## **Lung Metastases**

Lung metastases are cancer deposits that have spread to the lungs from another primary tumor and may cause cough, breathlessness, chest pain, or no symptoms.

## **Lung Needle Biopsy**

Lung needle biopsy examines lung needle biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lung PET Scan**

Lung PET scan examines lung pet scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lung Plethysmography**

Lung plethysmography examines lung plethysmography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lung Problems And Volcanic Smog**

Volcanic smog contains gases and fine particles that irritate eyes and airways and can worsen asthma or lung disease; limiting exposure and following public-health advice reduce harm.

## **Lung Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to lung surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Lung Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to lung surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Lupus - Resources**

Lupus - resources addresses care related to lupus - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a

clinician.

## **Luteinizing Hormone (LH) Blood Test**

Luteinizing hormone (LH) blood test examines luteinizing hormone (lh) blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lyme Disease - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Lyme disease - what to ask your doctor examines lyme disease - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lyme Disease Blood Test**

Lyme disease blood test examines lyme disease blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lymph Node Biopsy**

Lymph node biopsy examines lymph node biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lymph Node Culture**

Lymph node culture examines lymph node culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lymph System**

The lymph system includes lymph, lymphatic vessels, lymph nodes, spleen, thymus, and related tissues that return fluid and support immune defense.

## **Lymphangiogram**

A lymphangiogram uses contrast imaging to show lymphatic vessels and nodes, helping evaluate obstruction, leakage, malformation, or spread of disease.

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## **Lymphatic Obstruction**

Lymphatic obstruction examines lymphatic obstruction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Lymphedema - Self-Care**

Lymphedema self-care focuses on skin protection, exercise, compression when appropriate, limb elevation, infection prevention, and monitoring for worsening swelling or cellulitis.

## **Lymphofollicular Hyperplasia**

Lymphofollicular hyperplasia is enlargement or increased formation of lymphoid follicles in response to immune stimulation, infection, inflammation, or other triggers.

## **Lymphoid Hyperplasia**

Lymphoid hyperplasia is benign increase in lymphoid tissue caused by immune stimulation, infection, inflammation, or sometimes a reactive response near a tumor.

## **Labor False (Braxton Hicks Contractions)**

Alternate index label for Braxton Hicks Contractions.

## **Labyrinthitis (Inner Ear Inflammation)**

Alternate index label for Inner Ear Inflammation.

## **Laryngitis Contagious (Is Laryngitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Laryngitis Contagious.

## **Laryngotracheobronchitis (Croup)**

Alternate index label for Croup.

## **Larynx Cancer**

Laryngeal cancer is a malignant tumor of the voice box and may cause persistent hoarseness, swallowing pain, neck mass, ear pain, cough, or breathing difficulty. Diagnosis requires examination and biopsy; treatment depends on site and stage.

**Synonyms:**

Throat Cancer (Larynx Cancer)

## **Lateral Epicondylitis (Tennis Elbow (Lateral Epicondylitis))**

Alternate index label for Tennis Elbow (Lateral Epicondylitis).

## **Laxatives For Constipation**

Laxatives treat constipation through fiber and water retention, stool softening, osmotic effects, or increased bowel contractions. Choice depends on cause, duration, age, medicines, kidney function, and obstruction risk; persistent bleeding, vomiting, or severe pain needs evaluation.

**Synonyms:**

Constipation (Laxatives For Constipation)

## **Legionella Pneumonia (Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever)**

Alternate index label for Legionnaire Disease and Pontiac Fever.

## **Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever**

Legionnaires disease is a severe pneumonia caused by Legionella, while Pontiac fever is a milder flu-like illness from the same bacteria. Exposure to contaminated water systems is typical; pneumonia, confusion, low oxygen, or high fever requires urgent treatment.

**Synonyms:**

Legionella Pneumonia (Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever) Legionnaires Disease (Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever)

## **Legionnaires Disease (Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever)**

Alternate index label for Legionnaire Disease and Pontiac Fever.

## **Legs Restless (Restless Leg Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Restless Leg Syndrome.

## **Lesions On The Brain (Brain Lesions (Lesions On The Brain))**

Alternate index label for Brain Lesions (Lesions on

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the Brain).

### **Lice Vs Fleas**

Lice live on a human host, with head or body lice attaching eggs to hair or clothing, while fleas usually bite humans temporarily after living on animals or in the environment. Identification and environmental or contact treatment differ.

### **Lichen Ruber Planus (Lichen Planus)**

Alternate index label for Lichen Planus.

### **Lipodystrophy (Acquired Generalized And Inherited Lipodystrophy)**

Alternate index label for Acquired Generalized and Inherited Lipodystrophy.

### **Lipoma Vs. Liposarcoma**

A lipoma is a common benign fatty lump that is soft, mobile, and usually slow-growing. Liposarcoma is a malignant fat-containing tumor and may be deep, enlarging, firm, or painful; a changing or sizable mass requires imaging and specialist assessment.

### **Liver (Anatomy And Function)**

Alternate index label for Anatomy and Function.

### **Liver Function (Liver (Anatomy And Function))**

Alternate index label for Liver (Anatomy and Function).

### **Locked In Syndrome (Locked-In Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Locked-in Syndrome.

### **Loeys-Dietz Syndrome**

Loeys-Dietz syndrome is an inherited connective-tissue disorder associated with arterial aneurysm or dissection, distinctive skeletal and craniofacial features, allergic disease, and variable organ involvement. Lifelong vascular imaging and coordinated specialist care are important.

#### **Synonyms:**

Syndrome Loeys-Dietz (Loeys-Dietz Syndrome)

### **Loss Of Sense Of Smell And Taste With COVID-19**

COVID-19 can temporarily impair smell and taste through infection or inflammation of nasal and olfactory pathways. Most people improve, but persistent loss, distortion, poor nutrition, or neurologic symptoms warrants follow-up and smell-retraining advice.

### **Low Blood Pressure (Hypotension) Causes**

Alternate index label for Hypotension) Cause.

### **Low Neutrophil Count (Neutropenia)**

Alternate index label for Neutropenia.

### **Low Testosterone (Low T)**

Alternate index label for Low T.

### **Lumbago (Low Back Pain)**

Alternate index label for Low Back Pain.

### **Lumbar Lordosis Lower Spine**

Lumbar lordosis is the normal inward curve of the lower spine; excessive or reduced curvature may be associated with posture, muscle imbalance, hip disease, vertebral deformity, or pain. Examination and imaging are guided by symptoms rather than appearance alone.

### **Lung Anatomy (Lungs Design And Purpose)**

Alternate index label for Lungs Design And Purpose.

### **Lungs Design And Purpose**

The lungs exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide through branching airways and microscopic alveoli surrounded by capillaries. The airways filter, warm, and humidify air, while respiratory muscles drive ventilation; disease can impair airflow, diffusion, or blood flow.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lung Anatomy (Lungs Design And Purpose)

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### **Lungs Fluid (Pleural Effusion (Fluid In The Chest Or On Lung))**

Alternate index label for Pleural Effusion (Fluid In the Chest or On Lung).

### **Lupus (Systemic Lupus)**

Alternate index label for Systemic Lupus.

### **Lupus Contagious (Is Lupus Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Lupus Contagious.

### **Lyme Disease Contagious (Is Lyme Disease Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Lyme Disease Contagious.

### **Lymph Swollen Glands (Swollen Lymph Nodes)**

Alternate index label for Swollen Lymph Nodes.

### **Lymph Swollen Nodes (Swollen Lymph Nodes)**

Alternate index label for Swollen Lymph Nodes.

### **Lymphatic Obstruction (Lymphedema)**

Alternate index label for Lymphedema.

### **L1-L5 (Lumbar Vertebrae)**

The five lumbar vertebrae in the lower back, numbered L1 through L5, between the thoracic spine and sacrum and bearing much of the body's load.

### **Labia Majora**

The paired outer folds of skin of the vulva that help protect the urethral and vaginal openings and contain connective tissue, glands, and fat.

### **Labia Minora**

The paired inner folds of tissue of the vulva, lying within the labia majora and surrounding the vestibule and its openings.

### **Labial Sounds**

Speech sounds produced with one or both lips, such

as /p/, /b/, and /m/; lip movement and coordination can be relevant in speech assessment.

### **Labile**

Easily or rapidly changing, as in labile blood pressure, blood glucose, or mood.

### **Lability**

A tendency to change readily or unpredictably, such as emotional lability or labile blood pressure.

### **Labra**

Plural of labrum, referring to fibrocartilaginous rims that deepen certain joint sockets, such as the shoulder or hip labra.

### **Labrum**

A ring of fibrocartilage around a joint socket that deepens the socket and helps stabilize the joint, especially in the shoulder or hip.

### **Lacrimation**

Production and release of tears by the lacrimal glands; excessive tearing may result from irritation, allergy, infection, or blocked tear drainage.

### **LAMB Syndrome**

An older acronym for lentigines, atrial myxomas, mucocutaneous myxomas, and blue nevi, findings within the spectrum of Carney complex.

### **Landry Ascending Paralysis**

An older name for Guillain–Barré syndrome, an acute immune-mediated polyradiculoneuropathy causing progressive weakness that often begins in the legs and ascends; respiratory failure can occur.

### **Laparoscopic Cholecystectomy**

Surgical removal of the gallbladder through small abdominal incisions using a laparoscope and instruments, commonly performed for symptomatic gallstones or gallbladder inflammation.

### **Laryngeal**

Relating to the larynx, the organ in the throat

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containing the vocal cords and helping protect the airway.

### **Laryngectomy**

A person who has undergone laryngectomy, surgical removal of all or part of the larynx; total laryngectomy separates the airway from the mouth and nose.

### **Latent**

Present but inactive, hidden, or not currently producing symptoms, as in latent tuberculosis infection or a latent virus.

### **Lateral Canthotomy And Cantholysis**

An emergency procedure that cuts the outer corner of the eyelids and releases the lateral canthal tendon to reduce orbital pressure in suspected orbital compartment syndrome and protect vision.

### **Lateral X-Ray**

An X-ray image taken from the side, providing a lateral view of the body part being examined.

### **LAVH**

Abbreviation for laparoscopically assisted vaginal hysterectomy, removal of the uterus through the vagina with laparoscopic assistance.

### **Laying On Of Hands**

A religious or spiritual practice in which a person places hands on another for blessing, prayer, or healing; it should not replace evidence-based medical evaluation or treatment.

### **Lb.**

Abbreviation for pound, a unit of mass equal to 16 ounces or approximately 0.454 kilograms; medication weights should use unambiguous units.

### **LDL (Low-Density Lipoprotein)**

Low-density lipoprotein particles that transport cholesterol in blood; elevated LDL cholesterol contributes to atherosclerotic cardiovascular risk.

### **Left-Handed**

Having a preference for using the left hand for skilled activities; handedness is a normal form of human variation.

### **Leg Pain With Cramping**

Painful tightening or spasms in a leg muscle; causes include exertion, dehydration, medicines, nerve or muscle disorders, and reduced arterial blood flow causing intermittent claudication.

### **Legal Medicine**

The application of medical knowledge to legal questions, including forensic examination, injury assessment, death investigation, and issues of capacity or consent.

### **Leishmania Infection**

A parasitic infection caused by *Leishmania* protozoa and transmitted by infected sandflies; it can cause cutaneous, mucocutaneous, or visceral leishmaniasis.

### **Lennox-Gastaut Syndrome**

A severe childhood-onset developmental and epileptic encephalopathy with multiple seizure types, characteristic slow spike-and-wave EEG patterns, cognitive impairment, and often treatment-resistant seizures.

### **Leptomeningeal**

Relating to the pia mater and arachnoid mater, the two thin inner layers covering the brain and spinal cord; cancer or infection can spread in these layers.

### **Leu**

The standard amino-acid abbreviation for leucine, an essential branched-chain amino acid used in protein synthesis.

### **Leuk-**

A combining form meaning white, especially in terms relating to white blood cells, as in leukocyte.

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**Leuko-**

A combining form meaning white, as in leukoderma or leukopenia.

**Levo-**

A prefix meaning left or turning toward the left, often used in chemistry or to describe spatial orientation.

**Levothyroxine**

A synthetic form of thyroxine (T4) used as thyroid hormone replacement in hypothyroidism and in selected other thyroid conditions; dose is individualized and monitored with laboratory tests.

**Licensed Clinical Social Worker**

A social worker licensed to provide clinical assessment and psychotherapy or other mental-health services within the scope of local law and training.

**Lifestyle Disease**

A noncommunicable disease influenced by behaviors and living conditions, such as tobacco use, diet, inactivity, or alcohol; genetics, environment, and access to care also contribute.

**Lifetime Risk**

The probability that a person will develop a specified disease or experience an outcome during the remainder of their life or over a defined lifetime period.

**Lightening**

In late pregnancy, descent of the fetus into the pelvis before labor, which may reduce upper-abdominal pressure but increase pelvic pressure and urinary frequency.

**Lightheadedness**

A feeling of near-fainting, floating, or unsteadiness without necessarily perceiving that the surroundings are spinning; causes include dehydration, low blood pressure, anemia, medications, and heart or neurologic conditions.

**Lilliputian Hallucination**

A visual hallucination of unusually small people, animals, or objects; it can occur with neurologic, psychiatric, toxic, infectious, or sensory conditions.

**Line, Central**

A catheter whose tip lies in a large central vein, used to deliver medicines or fluids, monitor central venous pressure, draw blood, or provide specialized nutrition.

**Line, Central Venous**

A central venous catheter inserted into a large vein such as the internal jugular, subclavian, or femoral vein and advanced toward the superior or inferior vena cava.

**Lingual**

Relating to the tongue, including its muscles, nerves, blood supply, or surface.

**Linkage Analysis**

A genetic method that studies whether a disease trait and a genetic marker are inherited together, helping locate disease-associated regions in a family or population.

**Linkage Map**

A genetic map showing the relative positions of genes or markers based on recombination frequency, usually expressed in centimorgans rather than physical distance.

**Lipid Profile**

A blood test panel measuring lipids and lipoproteins, commonly including total cholesterol, LDL cholesterol, HDL cholesterol, and triglycerides.

**Lips**

The paired movable folds surrounding the opening of the mouth, involved in speech, facial expression, eating, and oral sensation.

**Liquid Diet**

A diet consisting partly or entirely of liquids; clear-



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liquid and full-liquid diets differ in allowed foods and may be prescribed temporarily for procedures, illness, or swallowing or digestive problems.

### **Liter**

A metric unit of volume equal to 1,000 milliliters or 1 cubic decimeter.

### **Litho-**

A combining form meaning stone, as in lithotripsy and nephrolithiasis.

### **Liver Shunt**

An abnormal or surgically created channel that diverts blood around the liver, such as a portosystemic shunt; it can reduce detoxification and contribute to hepatic encephalopathy.

### **Lizard Bite**

A puncture or tissue injury caused by a lizard; care includes cleaning and assessing for infection, tetanus, venom exposure, and significant tissue damage according to the species and circumstances.

### **LL**

Commonly an abbreviation for lower lid of the eye or lower limit; the intended meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **LLL**

Abbreviation for the left lower lobe of the lung.

### **LLQ**

Abbreviation for left lower quadrant, usually referring to the lower-left quarter of the abdomen.

### **LMP**

Abbreviation for last menstrual period, the first day of the most recent menstrual bleeding, used in estimating gestational age when the date is reliable.

### **Local Treatment**

Treatment directed at a specific body site or lesion rather than the whole body, such as a topical medicine, local injection, radiation field, or localized

procedure.

### **Locomotion**

Movement of an organism or person from one place to another using coordinated muscles, bones, nerves, and balance systems.

### **Locomotive System**

The musculoskeletal and nervous systems working together to produce posture, balance, and movement from place to place.

### **Locoregional**

Affecting a defined local area and nearby tissues or lymph nodes, without necessarily involving the whole body.

### **Locus Minoris Resistentiae**

Latin for a site of lesser resistance, meaning a body area considered more vulnerable to injury, infection, or disease because of local weakness or prior damage.

### **Long Arm Of A Chromosome**

The longer segment of a chromosome, designated q, extending from the centromere toward the chromosome's end.

### **Long-Term Care Facility**

A residential or care setting providing ongoing assistance, nursing, rehabilitation, or personal care to people who cannot live independently or need sustained support.

### **Longitudinal Section**

A cut or image made along the long axis of an organ, limb, vessel, or other structure.

### **Loss-Of-Function Mutation**

A genetic change that reduces or abolishes the normal activity or production of a gene product; its clinical effect depends on the gene, variant, and inheritance pattern.

### **Lou Gehrig Disease**

Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS), a progressive

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neurodegenerative disease affecting upper and lower motor neurons and causing weakness, muscle wasting, and eventual respiratory impairment.

### **Low-Set Ear**

An ear positioned lower on the side of the head than expected relative to facial landmarks; it may be an isolated variation or a feature of a genetic or developmental condition.

### **Lower Leg**

The part of the limb between the knee and ankle, containing the tibia, fibula, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

### **Lower Segment Cesarean Section (LSCS)**

A cesarean delivery performed through an incision in the lower uterine segment, usually through a low transverse uterine incision.

### **LP (Lumbar Puncture)**

A lumbar puncture, or spinal tap, is a procedure in which a needle is inserted into the lumbar subarachnoid space to measure pressure, collect cerebrospinal fluid for testing, or administer medication.

### **LPA**

LPA abbreviates Little People of America and may also refer to the left pulmonary artery.

### **LSD**

Lysergic acid diethylamide is a potent hallucinogen that can cause altered perception, visual hallucinations, autonomic effects, and unpredictable changes in mood and behavior.

### **Lues**

An older name for syphilis, an infection caused by the bacterium *Treponema pallidum*.

### **Luetic**

Relating to syphilis or to infection with *Treponema pallidum*.

### **LUL**

Abbreviation for the left upper lobe of the lung.

### **Lumbar**

Relating to the lower back, especially the region or five vertebrae between the thoracic spine and sacrum.

### **Lungs**

The paired respiratory organs in the chest that exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide between air and blood; they also contribute to acid–base regulation.

### **LUQ**

Abbreviation for the left upper quadrant of the abdomen.

### **Luxation**

Complete dislocation of a joint, in which the articular surfaces lose their normal contact.

### **LVF**

Abbreviation for left ventricular failure, meaning failure of the left side of the heart; it may also mean left ventricular function, depending on context.

### **Lymphatic Filariasis**

A mosquito-borne parasitic infection caused by filarial worms, most commonly *Wuchereria bancrofti*; adult worms inhabit lymphatic vessels and can cause chronic lymphatic obstruction, lymphedema, and elephantiasis.

### **Lymphocytic**

Relating to lymphocytes or characterized by an increased or predominant number of lymphocytes.

### **Lymphoid**

Resembling or relating to lymphatic tissue, lymphocytes, or organs involved in lymphocyte development and immune function.

### **Lysis**

The breakdown, dissolution, or destruction of cells or tissue; examples include hemolysis, the break-

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down of red blood cells, and thrombolysis, the dissolution of a blood clot.

### **Lytic**

Causing or involving lysis, or the breakdown of cells, tissue, or another biological structure; a lytic bone lesion is an area of bone destruction.

### **Lazy Eye (Amblyopia)**

Reduced vision in one or both eyes caused by abnormal visual development during childhood, often related to misalignment, unequal focusing, or visual obstruction.

### **Low Hemoglobin Count**

A hemoglobin level below the expected range, often indicating anemia from blood loss, reduced production, nutritional deficiency, inflammation, or increased destruction of red blood cells.

### **Laryngeal Warts (Recurrent Respiratory Papillomatosis)**

Benign papillomatous growths caused by HPV in the larynx or respiratory tract. They may cause hoarseness, stridor, or airway obstruction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Recurrent Respiratory Papillomatosis

### **Linear**

Arranged in a straight or nearly straight line, describing the shape or distribution of a skin lesion or eruption.

### **Localised**

Confined to a limited area or a small number of adjacent body sites rather than widespread.

### **Luteinizing Hormone-Releasing Hormone**

An older name for gonadotropin-releasing hormone (GnRH), a hypothalamic hormone released in pulses that stimulates the anterior pituitary to secrete luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone.

### **Learning Disabilities**

Persistent difficulties acquiring or using skills such as reading, writing, mathematics, language, attention, or coordination despite appropriate opportunity and instruction; assessment considers development, education, and other neurologic or sensory factors.

### **Lentigo Maligna Melanoma**

An invasive melanoma arising in a lentigo maligna on chronically sun-damaged skin, usually of the head or neck; it presents as an enlarging irregular pigmented patch or plaque.

### **Lichen Planopilaris**

A lymphocytic inflammatory scalp disorder that attacks hair follicles and can cause scarring alopecia, perifollicular scale, redness, and permanent hair loss.

### **Liposarcoma Of The Breast**

A rare malignant mesenchymal tumor with adipocytic differentiation arising in breast soft tissue. Diagnosis requires histopathologic and molecular evaluation, and treatment is generally wide excision with sarcoma-focused care.

### **Lymphocytic Mastitis**

A benign fibroinflammatory breast lesion with dense lymphocytic infiltration and stromal fibrosis, classically associated with diabetes or autoimmune disease and also called diabetic mastopathy. It can mimic carcinoma clinically and radiologically.

### **Lichenoid Drug Eruption**

A lichenoid inflammatory skin reaction caused by a medicine, often resembling lichen planus but with a broader distribution or different clinical and histologic features; improvement may follow withdrawal of the culprit drug.

### **Livedoid Vasculopathy**

A chronic occlusive disorder of small dermal vessels causing painful purpuric lesions, ulcers, and porcelain-white stellate scars, usually on the lower legs and ankles.

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### **Lupus Panniculitis**

A chronic inflammatory form of cutaneous lupus affecting subcutaneous fat, producing firm deep nodules that may heal with lipoatrophy, scarring, or overlying discoid changes.

### **Low-Grade Appendiceal Mucinous Neoplasm**

A mucin-producing appendiceal neoplasm with low-grade cytologic atypia that may dilate the appendix and rupture, disseminating mucin into the peritoneum as pseudomyxoma peritonei.

### **Leiomyomatosis Peritonealis Disseminata**

A rare benign condition with multiple smooth-muscle nodules scattered over the peritoneum, often associated with pregnancy or hormonal stimulation and sometimes mimicking peritoneal carcinomatosis.

### **Leiomyosarcoma Of The Vulva**

A rare malignant smooth-muscle tumor of the vulva, usually presenting as a solitary enlarging mass. Histologic atypia, mitotic activity, necrosis, and invasion help determine malignant behavior.

### **Large Solitary Luteinized Follicle Cyst Of Pregnancy**

A benign ovarian cystic lesion with prominent luteinization, usually occurring during pregnancy and often discovered incidentally or as an adnexal mass.

### **Luteoma Of Pregnancy**

A benign, pregnancy-associated ovarian proliferation of luteinized stromal cells driven by hormonal stimulation. It may cause maternal or fetal androgen excess and usually regresses after delivery.

### **Low-Grade Central Osteosarcoma**

A rare low-grade malignant osteogenic tumor arising within the medullary cavity of bone. It may resemble fibrous dysplasia or a benign fibro-osseous lesion and requires complete oncologic excision.

### **Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**

A clonal disorder in which abnormal Langerhans cells accumulate in one or more organs, commonly bone, skin, lungs, lymph nodes, or the pituitary. Disease may be single-system or multisystem and ranges from self-limited lesions to life-threatening organ dysfunction. Clinical features depend on the involved organs and may include bone pain, skin eruptions, cough, diabetes insipidus, cytopenias, or hepatosplenomegaly. Diagnosis requires tissue evaluation with appropriate immunophenotyping and staging; treatment is guided by extent, risk-organ involvement, and clinical severity.

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### MacConkey Agar

A selective and differential culture medium used mainly for gram-negative bacteria. Bile salts and crystal violet inhibit many gram-positive organisms, while lactose fermentation produces different colony colors and helps distinguish bacterial groups.

### Macrophage

A macrophage is a tissue-resident or recruited phagocytic immune cell derived mainly from monocytes; it ingests microbes and debris, presents antigen, and releases mediators that regulate inflammation and repair.

### Magenblase Syndrome

Stomach discomfort and bloating caused by swallowing excessive air while eating.

### Maceration

Softening and breakdown of tissue caused by prolonged exposure to moisture or fluid; it may occur in skin, wounds, or a fetus after death.

### Macrocephalus

Having an abnormally large head, usually defined by head circumference above the expected range for age and sex.

### Macrocyte

An abnormally large red blood cell, commonly seen in macrocytosis and megaloblastic or other anemias.

### Macrocytic Anaemia

Anemia in which red blood cells are larger than normal, often caused by vitamin B12 or folate deficiency but also by other conditions or medicines.

### Macroscopic

Visible to the unaided eye, as opposed to microscopic.

### Madarosis

Loss or absence of eyelashes, eyebrows, or other hair, caused by local disease, inflammation, trauma, or systemic conditions.

### Maddock's Disease

A rare historical eponym whose meaning is not consistent across medical references; the original source should be checked before clinical use.

### Madura Foot

A chronic localized infection of the foot or other tissue, also called mycetoma, producing swelling, draining sinuses, and grains.

### Maduramycosis

Mycetoma, a chronic subcutaneous infection caused by true fungi or filamentous bacteria and characterized by swelling, sinuses, and granules.

### Magnesium Carbonate

A magnesium salt used in some antacid or laxative preparations and as a magnesium supplement; excessive intake may cause toxicity, especially in renal failure.

### Magnesium Hydroxide

An osmotic laxative and antacid that neutralizes gastric acid and draws water into the bowel.

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## **Magnesium Sulphate**

A magnesium salt used medically for severe magnesium deficiency, prevention or treatment of eclamptic seizures, and selected arrhythmias or asthma indications.

## **Magnetism**

The physical property by which magnetic fields exert forces; it is important in MRI and requires screening for ferromagnetic hazards.

## **Magnetocardiography**

Recording of the magnetic fields produced by electrical activity of the heart, usually with highly sensitive external sensors.

## **Magnetoencephalography**

Recording of the magnetic fields generated by neuronal electrical activity, used to localize brain function or epileptic activity.

## **Main-En-Griffe**

A claw-hand deformity caused by lower brachial-plexus or ulnar-nerve dysfunction, with hyperextension at the MCP joints and flexion at the IP joints.

## **Maize**

Corn, a cereal grain used as food and feed; contaminated maize can expose people to fungal toxins such as aflatoxin.

## **Major Tranquillizers**

An older term for antipsychotic medicines, used to reduce psychosis, severe agitation, or mania.

## **Malacia**

Abnormal softening of tissue, such as cartilage, bone, or brain tissue.

## **Maladaptation**

An adjustment to a situation or environment that is ineffective or harmful to health or functioning.

## **Malar**

Relating to the cheekbone or cheek region.

## **Malassimilation**

Failure to properly digest or absorb nutrients, encompassing maldigestion and malabsorption.

## **Male Reproductive System**

The organs and tissues that produce sperm and male sex hormones and deliver sperm, including the testes, ducts, accessory glands, penis, and scrotum.

## **Malformation**

An abnormal structural development present from birth, caused by disturbed formation of an organ or body part.

## **Malignant Pustule**

An older name for the skin form of anthrax, caused by *Bacillus anthracis* and beginning as an itchy papule that develops into a painless black eschar.

## **Malleolus**

A bony prominence at the ankle formed by the lower end of the tibia medially or fibula laterally.

## **Malpighian Bodies**

Renal glomeruli within Bowman's capsules, where blood filtration begins; the term may also refer historically to lymphoid nodules in the spleen.

## **Malposition**

An abnormal position of an organ, body part, or fetus.

## **Malt-Worker's Lung**

An occupational hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhalation of organic dusts associated with malting or grain processing.

## **Malta Fever**

Brucellosis, a zoonotic infection caused by *Brucella* species and characterized by intermittent fever, sweats, fatigue, and joint or systemic symptoms.



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**Maltase**

An intestinal enzyme that breaks maltose into two glucose molecules.

**Mamillary**

A misspelling or variant of mamillary, meaning relating to the breast or to a rounded nipple-like structure.

**Mammary Glands**

Paired milk-producing glands in the breasts, composed of lobules and ducts that develop and function under hormonal control.

**Mammoplasty**

Plastic or reconstructive surgery to alter the size, shape, or contour of the breast.

**Mandibular**

Relating to the mandible or lower jaw.

**Maniac-Depressive Psychosis**

An obsolete term for bipolar disorder, characterized by episodes of mania or hypomania and episodes of depression.

**Manifest**

Clearly apparent or expressed; in clinical usage, a disease may manifest through particular signs or symptoms.

**Manipulation**

Deliberate physical movement of a body part or joint, often performed therapeutically or diagnostically by a trained clinician.

**Manometer**

An instrument for measuring pressure in a fluid or gas, including pressure in blood vessels or body cavities.

**Mantoux Test**

An intradermal tuberculin skin test in which induration is measured after 48 to 72 hours; it indicates immune sensitization, not by itself active tuberculo-

sis.

**Manual**

Performed by hand, or a written guide describing procedures, instructions, or reference information.

**Manus**

The hand, including the wrist and fingers, in anatomical terminology.

**Marantic**

Relating to a sterile, noninfective process associated with wasting; marantic endocarditis refers to nonbacterial thrombotic endocarditis.

**Marble Bone Disease**

Osteopetrosis, an inherited disorder of defective bone resorption causing abnormally dense but fragile bones and possible marrow failure.

**Marfan's Syndrome**

An inherited connective-tissue disorder, usually caused by FBN1 variants, affecting the aorta, eyes, skeleton, and other organs.

**Marijuana**

Cannabis preparations containing cannabinoids such as THC; medical effects and risks depend on dose, formulation, route, and patient factors.

**Synonyms:**

Pot Marijuana (Marijuana)

**Marital Disharmony**

Persistent conflict or distress in a marriage or partnership that may contribute to psychological symptoms or require relationship-focused support.

**Marrow**

The soft tissue inside bones, including red marrow that produces blood cells and yellow marrow rich in fat.

**Marsupialization**

A surgical technique that opens a cyst or abscess and sutures its edges to the surrounding skin or

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mucosa to permit continuing drainage.

### **Martin-Bell Syndrome**

An older name for fragile X syndrome, an inherited neurodevelopmental disorder caused by CGG-repeat expansion in the FMR1 gene.

### **Masculinization**

Development of male-typical physical characteristics, caused by normal puberty, androgen excess, androgen treatment, or certain disorders.

### **Mask**

A device placed over the face to deliver oxygen, anesthesia, ventilation, or protection; the meaning depends on clinical context.

### **Masochism**

Sexual or nonsexual arousal or gratification associated with receiving pain, humiliation, or degradation; distress or impairment determines clinical significance.

### **Mass**

A localized area of tissue that is larger or more substantial than surrounding tissue and may be benign, malignant, inflammatory, or cystic.

### **Masseter**

A powerful muscle of chewing that elevates the mandible and lies over the lateral surface of the mandibular ramus.

### **Mastication**

Chewing, the mechanical breakdown of food in the mouth before swallowing.

### **Mastoid**

Relating to or forming the mastoid portion of the temporal bone behind the ear.

### **Mastoid Antrum**

An air-containing cavity in the mastoid portion of the temporal bone that communicates with the middle-ear attic.

### **Mastodynia**

Breast pain or tenderness, also called mastalgia.

### **Mastoid Process**

The rounded bony projection of the temporal bone behind the ear, providing attachment for neck muscles.

### **Match-Box Test**

A historical clinical test whose exact purpose varies by source; it should not be interpreted without the original examination description.

### **Materia Medica**

An older term for the body of medicinal substances and information about their properties and uses.

### **Maternal Mortality Rate**

The number of maternal deaths related to pregnancy per 100,000 live births in a specified population and period.

### **Maternity**

The state or service relating to pregnancy, childbirth, and the care of the mother and newborn.

### **Maternity Services**

Healthcare services providing antenatal, intrapartum, postpartum, and newborn care.

### **Maturation**

The process by which cells, tissues, organs, or an individual develop toward functional maturity.

### **Mature Onset Diabetes**

An older term generally referring to type 2 diabetes mellitus, which often develops in adulthood, though diabetes classification depends on cause rather than age alone.

### **Maxillary**

Relating to the maxilla or upper jaw.

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### **Maximal Breathing Capacity**

The greatest volume of air that can be moved in and out of the lungs in a specified period during maximal effort; it is related to but distinct from standard spirometric measures.

### **Maximum Allowable Concentration**

The highest permitted concentration of a substance in a workplace or environment under a specified regulatory standard and exposure period.

### **May-Hegglin Anomaly**

An inherited MYH9-related disorder with macrothrombocytopenia, giant platelets, and characteristic leukocyte inclusions; hearing, kidney, or cataract abnormalities may occur.

### **Meadow Saffron**

*Colchicum autumnale*, a plant containing colchicine; ingestion can cause severe gastrointestinal illness, multiorgan toxicity, and death.

### **Measurement**

The process of determining the size, amount, concentration, or value of a clinical or biological variable.

### **Meatal**

Relating to a meatus or bodily opening.

### **Meatus**

An opening or passage leading into or out of a body structure, such as the urethral or auditory meatus.

### **Mebendazole**

An anthelmintic medicine used to treat several intestinal worm infections by impairing parasite microtubules.

### **Meckel's Diverticulum**

A congenital pouch of the small intestine caused by persistence of the embryonic vitelline duct; it may bleed, obstruct, or become inflamed.

### **Meconium**

The thick, dark first stool of a newborn, composed

of intestinal secretions, shed cells, mucus, and swallowed amniotic material.

### **Median**

Located in or relating to the middle plane or midpoint of a structure.

### **Medical Certificate**

A document completed by an authorized healthcare professional that records a medical finding, diagnosis, fitness status, or period of illness.

### **Medical Officer**

A physician appointed to provide clinical care or medical oversight for an institution, service, or organization.

### **Medical Practitioner**

A licensed physician qualified to diagnose, prevent, and treat illness.

### **Medical Research Council (MRC)**

An organization or scale associated with medical research; the MRC muscle-power scale grades strength from 0 to 5.

### **Medicinal**

Used for the prevention, diagnosis, relief, or treatment of disease.

### **Medicine**

A substance, preparation, or therapeutic practice used to prevent, diagnose, relieve, or treat disease.

### **Medico-Legal**

Relating to the application of medical knowledge to legal questions or proceedings.

### **Medium**

A substance or condition through which something occurs; in microbiology, a culture medium supports the growth of microorganisms.

### **Medulla**

The inner or central part of an organ, such as the

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renal medulla or adrenal medulla.

### **Medullary**

Relating to the medulla or inner portion of an organ.

### **Mega-**

A combining form meaning large, great, or abnormally enlarged.

### **Megakaryocyte**

A large bone-marrow cell that extends cytoplasmic processes and releases platelets.

### **Megacolon**

Abnormal enlargement and dilation of the colon, which may be congenital, acquired, toxic, or inflammatory.

### **Megaloblast**

An abnormally large, immature red-cell precursor in bone marrow, typically reflecting impaired DNA synthesis.

### **Megaloblastic Anaemia**

Macrocytic anemia caused by defective DNA synthesis, most often from vitamin B12 or folate deficiency.

### **Megalocephaly**

Abnormally large head size, which may be familial, developmental, metabolic, or associated with brain disease.

### **Megrim**

An older term for migraine, a recurrent headache disorder often associated with nausea and sensitivity to light or sound.

### **Meibomian Glands**

Sebaceous glands in the eyelids that produce the oily layer of the tear film and help prevent tear evaporation.

### **Meigs' Syndrome**

The triad of an ovarian fibroma, ascites, and pleural effusion, with resolution of the fluid after tumor

removal.

### **Meissner's Corpuscles**

Encapsulated sensory receptors in hairless skin that detect light touch and low-frequency vibration.

### **Melancholia**

An older term for severe depression, often describing pervasive sadness, loss of pleasure, psychomotor change, and biological symptoms.

### **Melanoblast**

A precursor cell that develops into a melanocyte and produces pigment after migrating into the skin and other tissues.

### **Melanosis**

Abnormal accumulation or increased production of melanin in skin, mucosa, an organ, or other tissue.

### **Melena**

Black, tarry, often foul-smelling stool caused usually by digested blood from upper gastrointestinal bleeding.

### **Melibiose**

A disaccharide composed of galactose and glucose, produced by hydrolysis of raffinose and metabolized by some microorganisms.

### **Melio**

An older shortened form related to melioidosis, the infection caused by *Burkholderia pseudomallei*.

### **Melitensis**

A species designation, especially *Brucella melitensis*, a bacterium that causes brucellosis and is associated with goats and sheep.

### **Melphalan**

An alkylating antineoplastic medicine used in selected plasma-cell disorders and other cancers.

### **Membranous**

Relating to, consisting of, or resembling a mem-

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brane.

### **Mendelian Inheritance**

Inheritance of traits determined by single genes and transmitted according to dominant, recessive, or sex-linked patterns.

### **Meniere's Disease**

An inner-ear disorder causing episodic vertigo, fluctuating sensorineural hearing loss, tinnitus, and aural pressure.

### **Meningismus**

Neck stiffness and other meningeal-irritation signs without proven inflammation of the meninges.

### **Meningococcus**

*Neisseria meningitidis*, a bacterium that can cause meningitis and rapidly progressive bloodstream infection.

### **Meningomyelocele**

A neural-tube defect in which meninges and spinal cord tissue protrude through a vertebral opening.

### **Meniscectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of a torn knee meniscus.

### **Meniscus**

A crescent-shaped fibrocartilage structure in the knee, or a curved fluid surface in a container.

### **Menopausal**

Relating to menopause or the transition around the end of menstrual periods.

### **Mensa**

A table or flat surface; in anatomy, the term may describe a flat surface of a structure and is context-dependent.

### **Menstrual**

Relating to menstruation or the menstrual cycle.

### **Mental**

Relating to the mind, cognition, emotion, or behavior.

### **Mental Age**

An estimate of cognitive functioning expressed as the age level at which a standardized test score is typical; it is not the same as chronological age.

### **Mental Deficiency**

An obsolete and stigmatizing term formerly used for intellectual disability; current terminology is intellectual disability.

### **Mental Disorder**

A clinically significant disturbance in cognition, emotion regulation, or behavior that causes distress, impairment, or both.

### **Mental Handicap**

An obsolete term for intellectual disability or cognitive impairment; current language should be used.

### **Mental Illness**

A broad term for mental disorders that affect mood, thinking, behavior, or functioning.

### **Mental Retardation**

An obsolete and stigmatizing term formerly used for intellectual disability; it should not be used in current clinical communication.

### **Mentation**

The process of thinking, perceiving, reasoning, and other mental activity.

### **Menthol**

A mint-derived or synthetic compound producing a cooling sensation and used in some topical and respiratory preparations.

### **Mepacrine**

An older antimalarial and antiprotozoal medicine, also called quinacrine, now used only in selected indications.

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## Meperidine

An opioid analgesic, also called pethidine, whose use is limited by adverse effects and an active neurotoxic metabolite.

## Mephenesin

An older centrally acting muscle relaxant with sedative properties.

## Mephentermine

A sympathomimetic medicine formerly used to raise blood pressure in selected hypotensive states.

## Mepivacaine

An amide local anesthetic used for infiltration, nerve blocks, and regional anesthesia.

## Meproamate

An older anxiolytic and sedative medicine with dependence and overdose risks.

## Mepyramine

An antihistamine that blocks H1 receptors and may cause sedation; it is also called pyrilamine.

## Meralgia Paresthetica

Burning, tingling, or numbness over the outer thigh caused by compression of the lateral femoral cutaneous nerve.

### Synonyms:

Burning Thigh Pain

## Mercaptopurine

A thiopurine antimetabolite used in selected leukemias and inflammatory disorders, requiring monitoring for marrow and liver toxicity.

## Mercurialism

Chronic poisoning by mercury, potentially causing neurologic, psychiatric, renal, gastrointestinal, or oral effects.

## Meridian

A reference line or plane; in traditional acupuncture it denotes a proposed pathway for qi, while in

anatomy it may describe a longitudinal line.

## Mermaid Syndrome

An extremely rare congenital anomaly in which the legs are fused to varying degrees, also called sirenomelia.

## Merycism

Rumination, the repeated regurgitation and rechewing of food after eating.

## Mes-

A combining form meaning middle.

## Mescaline

A naturally occurring psychedelic substance found in certain cacti that alters perception and may cause hallucinations and autonomic effects.

## Mesenchyme

Embryonic connective tissue that gives rise to much of the skeleton, connective tissue, blood vessels, and smooth muscle.

## Mesenteric

Relating to the mesentery or its blood vessels, nerves, lymphatics, and fat.

## Mesial

Situated toward the midline; in dentistry, toward the front or midline of a tooth.

## Meso-

A combining form meaning middle.

## Mesomorph

A body-build classification characterized traditionally by relatively prominent muscle and bone; it is descriptive, not a diagnosis.

## Mesothelioma

A malignant tumor of mesothelial surfaces, most often the pleura and commonly associated with asbestos exposure.



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**Mestranol**

A synthetic estrogen formerly used in some combined oral contraceptives.

**Metabolic**

Relating to metabolism, the chemical processes by which cells produce and use energy and materials.

**Metabolite**

A substance produced or consumed during metabolism of a drug, nutrient, or endogenous molecule.

**Metacarpal**

Relating to one of the five bones forming the palm of the hand.

**Metacarpus**

The part of the hand between the wrist and fingers, containing the five metacarpal bones.

**Metachromatic Leukodystrophy**

An inherited lysosomal-storage disorder caused by deficient arylsulfatase A activity, leading to sulfatide accumulation and progressive demyelination.

**Metaphase**

The stage of cell division in which chromosomes align at the cell's equatorial plane.

**Metatarsal**

Relating to one of the five long bones forming the forefoot.

**Metatarsalgia**

Pain in the front or ball of the foot, often arising from pressure or irritation around the metatarsal heads.

**Metatarsus**

The part of the foot between the tarsal bones and toes, containing the five metatarsal bones.

**Metathesis**

Transposition or rearrangement of sounds in a word; in chemistry or biology, it can mean exchange of parts or groups.

**Meteorism**

Abdominal distension caused by excessive gas in the gastrointestinal tract.

**Meter**

A metric unit of length equal to 100 centimeters; medical usage may also refer to a measuring device.

**Methadone**

A long-acting opioid used for pain in selected cases and for opioid-use-disorder treatment.

**Methamphetamines**

Powerful synthetic stimulant drugs with substantial risks of dependence, cardiovascular toxicity, psychosis, and neurotoxicity.

**Methanol**

A toxic alcohol whose metabolites can cause metabolic acidosis, visual injury, and death.

**Methantheline**

An older anticholinergic medicine formerly used for gastrointestinal spasm and hyperhidrosis.

**Methemoglobin**

Hemoglobin containing oxidized iron that cannot bind oxygen normally.

**Methicillin**

A former penicillin antibiotic used historically to treat staphylococcal infections; resistance is mediated by altered penicillin-binding protein.

**Methimazole**

An antithyroid medicine that inhibits thyroid hormone synthesis.

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### **Methionine**

An essential sulfur-containing amino acid used in protein synthesis and methyl-group metabolism.

### **Methisazone**

An older antiviral compound investigated or used historically against poxvirus infections.

### **Methotrexate**

An antimetabolite that inhibits folate-dependent enzymes and is used in cancer and selected autoimmune or inflammatory disorders.

### **Methoxyflurane**

A volatile anesthetic formerly used for general anesthesia and, in some settings, low-dose analgesia.

### **Methyl Alcohol**

Another name for methanol, a toxic alcohol that can cause severe acidosis and blindness.

### **Methylcellulose**

A cellulose derivative used as a bulk-forming laxative, thickener, and excipient.

### **Methyldopa**

A centrally acting alpha-2 agonist used mainly in selected cases of hypertension, including pregnancy.

### **Methylergometrine**

An ergot alkaloid that increases uterine contraction and may be used to control postpartum hemorrhage when appropriate.

### **Methylmorphine**

Another name for codeine, an opioid analgesic and antitussive.

### **Methylphenidate**

A central nervous system stimulant used mainly for ADHD and narcolepsy.

### **Methylprednisolone**

A synthetic glucocorticoid used to suppress inflam-

mation and immune activity.

### **Methyltestosterone**

An androgen medicine formerly used in selected hypogonadal or palliative indications; it can cause hepatic and other adverse effects.

### **Metolazone**

A thiazide-like diuretic used for hypertension and fluid retention, often with a loop diuretic.

### **Metritis**

Inflammation of the uterus, often occurring after childbirth, miscarriage, or uterine infection.

### **Metrorrhagia**

Uterine bleeding occurring at irregular times, including between expected menstrual periods.

### **Metyrapone**

A medicine that inhibits 11-beta-hydroxylase and is used in selected endocrine tests or treatment.

### **Mexican Tea**

A traditional name for medicinal plants or preparations used in Mexico; the exact species and safety depend on the source.

### **Mezlocillin**

A penicillin antibiotic of the acylureido group, formerly used against susceptible gram-negative and other bacteria.

### **Mi-**

A combining form meaning small or relating to muscle, depending on the word in which it appears.

### **Mica**

A group of sheet silicate minerals; inhalation of mica dust can cause occupational lung disease.

### **Mice**

Plural of mouse; laboratory mice are widely used in biomedical research and can also transmit zoonotic infections.

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**Micro-**

A combining form meaning small or millionth, depending on context.

**Microbiology**

The study of microorganisms, including bacteria, viruses, fungi, and parasites.

**Microcirculation**

Blood flow through arterioles, capillaries, and venules, where tissue exchange occurs.

**Micrococcus**

A genus of generally harmless gram-positive cocci that can occasionally cause opportunistic infection.

**Microdontia**

Abnormally small teeth, which may affect one or several teeth and can be inherited or developmental.

**Microfauna**

Small or microscopic animals, including protozoa and tiny invertebrates, found in an environment or specimen.

**Microfilaria**

The larval form of filarial worms, circulating in blood or skin and transmitted by insect vectors.

**Microflora**

An older term for the microorganisms inhabiting a body site or environment; microbiota is preferred.

**Micrographia**

Abnormally small handwriting, commonly associated with Parkinson disease and other neurologic disorders.

**Micrometer**

An instrument or unit used to measure very small distances; one micrometer is one-millionth of a meter.

**Micron**

A unit of length equal to one micrometer, or one-millionth of a meter.

**Microorganism**

A microscopic living organism, such as a bacterium, fungus, protozoan, or alga; viruses are acellular infectious agents.

**Microphone**

A device that converts sound into an electrical signal, used in hearing assessment, recording, or communication equipment.

**Micropsia**

A visual disturbance in which objects appear smaller than they are.

**Microscopic**

Visible only with a microscope or relating to microscopic examination.

**Microscopy**

Examination of cells, tissues, organisms, or materials using a microscope.

**Microsecond**

A unit of time equal to one-millionth of a second.

**Micro-Surgery**

Surgery performed with magnification and fine instruments to repair very small structures such as nerves and vessels.

**Microtome**

An instrument that cuts extremely thin sections of tissue for microscopic examination.

**Mid-Brain**

The midbrain, or mesencephalon, is the upper part of the brainstem involved in eye movements, motor pathways, and auditory and visual reflexes.

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### **Mid-Day**

The middle part of the day; in clinical instructions it may specify a medication or measurement time.

### **Mid-Dorsal**

Situated in the middle region of the back or on the dorsal side of a structure.

### **Mid-Forearm**

The region halfway between the elbow and wrist.

### **Mid-Gut**

The embryonic middle portion of the primitive gut, which develops into much of the small intestine and proximal colon.

### **Mid-Leg**

The central region of the lower limb between the knee and ankle.

### **Mid-Line**

The imaginary or anatomical line dividing a structure or body into right and left portions.

### **Midriff**

The region of the trunk around the diaphragm and upper abdomen.

### **Mid-Sized**

Of intermediate size; it is a descriptive term rather than a specific medical diagnosis.

### **Mid-Stream Urine Specimen**

A urine sample collected after initial urine is voided, reducing contamination from the urethral opening and used commonly for culture.

### **Midwife**

A trained and regulated professional who provides care during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the post-natal period.

### **Midwifery**

The professional practice of supporting and man-

aging normal pregnancy, childbirth, postpartum recovery, and newborn care.

### **Migraine**

A recurrent neurologic headache disorder causing moderate or severe headache, often with nausea and sensitivity to light or sound, with or without aura.

### **Migration**

Movement of cells, organisms, substances, or a body structure from one location to another.

### **Mikulicz's Disease**

An older term for persistent, usually symmetrical enlargement of the lacrimal and salivary glands, now often considered within IgG4-related disease or Sjögren syndrome.

### **Miliaria**

A sweat-retention disorder caused by blockage of eccrine ducts, producing small itchy or prickly papules.

### **Miliary**

Resembling millet seeds; in medicine, describing numerous tiny lesions, especially the pattern of disseminated tuberculosis.

### **Miliaria Rubra**

An itchy prickly heat rash caused by sweat-duct blockage in the epidermis, producing small red papules or vesicles.

### **Milium**

A small, firm, white or yellow keratin-filled cyst, usually on the face; plural milia.

### **Milk**

A nutrient-rich secretion of mammary glands used to feed an infant.

### **Milk-Alkali Syndrome**

Hypercalcemia, metabolic alkalosis, and kidney dysfunction caused by excessive calcium and absorbable alkali intake.

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**Milker's Node**

A localized nodular skin infection caused by parapoxvirus acquired from infected cattle, also called orf-like milker's nodule.

**Milk Fever**

Hypocalcemia around calving in dairy cattle; in human medicine, the term is sometimes used loosely for postpartum hypocalcemia but is not a standard diagnosis.

**Milk-Leg**

An older term for postpartum swelling of a leg, historically associated with deep venous thrombosis or lymphatic obstruction.

**Milk Of Magnesia**

A suspension of magnesium hydroxide used as an antacid and osmotic laxative.

**Milk-Sickness**

A historical poisoning caused by drinking milk from cattle that have eaten white snakeroot containing tremetol.

**Milky Urine**

Urine with a cloudy or white appearance caused by chyle, pus, crystals, fat, or other substances; evaluation identifies the cause.

**Milliequivalent**

A unit expressing the chemical combining power of an ion, equal to one-thousandth of an equivalent.

**Milligram**

A unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a gram.

**Milligram-Percent**

An older concentration unit meaning milligrams per 100 milliliters, numerically equivalent to mg/dL.

**Milliliter**

A unit of volume equal to one-thousandth of a liter and one cubic centimeter.

**Millimeter**

A unit of length equal to one-thousandth of a meter.

**Millimole**

A unit of amount of substance equal to one-thousandth of a mole.

**Million**

A number equal to 1,000,000; laboratory counts may use it as a numerical multiplier.

**Millivolt**

A unit of electrical potential equal to one-thousandth of a volt.

**Milroy's Disease**

An inherited form of primary lymphedema, usually present from birth or early life and caused commonly by lymphatic-development abnormalities.

**Mima**

A rare or historical term whose clinical meaning is not consistent across references; the source-specific definition should be verified.

**Mimicry**

Resemblance of one organism, structure, or clinical pattern to another; in medicine, it may describe a disorder that imitates another disease.

**Minamata Disease**

A neurologic disorder caused by methylmercury poisoning, classically from contaminated seafood or industrial pollution.

**Mineral**

An inorganic element or compound required for body structure, fluid balance, enzyme activity, or other physiological functions.

**Mineralocorticoids**

Steroid hormones, chiefly aldosterone, that promote sodium retention and potassium and hydrogen secretion in the kidney.

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### **Miner's Anaemia**

Anemia associated historically with mining, commonly due to hookworm infection, chronic blood loss, nutritional deficiency, or occupational exposure.

### **Miner's Asthma**

Asthma or asthma-like airway disease associated with inhalation of dusts encountered in mining.

### **Miner's Nystagmus**

An older term for visual disturbance and nystagmus reported in underground miners, associated with poor lighting and occupational conditions.

### **Mini-Stroke**

A lay term usually referring to a transient ischemic attack, in which focal neurologic symptoms resolve without persistent infarction.

### **Minim**

A very small amount or unit; the term is historical and may refer to a small volume in old pharmaceutical measurement.

### **Minimal Brain Dysfunction**

An obsolete term formerly used for children with attention, learning, or behavior problems; it has no precise modern diagnostic meaning.

### **Minimally Invasive Surgery**

Surgery performed through small incisions or natural openings using specialized instruments, usually reducing tissue disruption and recovery time.

### **Minimization**

A psychological or communication process of downplaying the importance or severity of symptoms, events, or problems.

### **Minimum Lethal Dose**

The smallest dose of a substance reported to cause death under specified conditions; it varies by species, route, and individual.

### **Minocycline**

A tetracycline antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections and inflammatory acne.

### **Minoxidil**

A vasodilator used topically for pattern hair loss and orally in selected cases of resistant hypertension.

### **Miracidium**

The ciliated larval stage of a trematode that hatches from an egg and infects a suitable snail host.

### **Mirror-Writing**

Writing in which letters or words are reversed as if seen in a mirror; it may occur transiently in childhood or with neurologic disease.

### **Miscarriage**

Spontaneous loss of a pregnancy before fetal viability, commonly caused by chromosomal abnormalities but requiring clinical assessment.

### **Miscarriage, Spontaneous**

Pregnancy loss occurring without an intentional medical or surgical procedure.

### **Miserere**

An obsolete term for feculent vomiting associated with severe intestinal obstruction.

### **Misoprostol**

A prostaglandin E1 analogue used for ulcer prevention in selected patients, medical abortion, cervical preparation, and obstetric indications.

### **Mite**

A tiny arachnid; some mites cause dermatitis or transmit disease, and house-dust mites can trigger allergy.

### **Mithramycin**

An older antineoplastic antibiotic, also called plinabycin, whose use is limited by substantial toxicity.



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## **Mitral**

Relating to the mitral or bicuspid valve between the left atrium and left ventricle.

## **Mitral Atresia**

Congenital absence or complete closure of the mitral-valve opening, causing severe obstruction of blood flow into the left ventricle.

## **Mitral Insufficiency**

Failure of the mitral valve to close completely, allowing blood to leak back into the left atrium during systole.

## **Mitral Valvotomy**

An operation or catheter procedure that splits or widens a narrowed mitral valve.

## **Mittelschmerz**

One-sided lower-abdominal pain occurring around ovulation.

## **Mixed Oedema**

Edema caused by more than one mechanism or affecting more than one tissue compartment; interpretation depends on clinical context.

## **Mixovirus**

An older group name for certain myxovirus-like viruses, including viruses historically associated with influenza and other respiratory infections.

## **Mobile**

Capable of moving or being moved; a mass or structure described as mobile is not fixed to adjacent tissue.

## **Mobility**

The ability to move or be moved, including functional movement of a person or range of motion of a joint.

## **Mobilization**

The process of restoring or encouraging movement, such as early patient activity, joint movement, or

surgical release of tissue.

## **Modality**

A method or form of treatment, diagnosis, imaging, or sensory stimulation.

## **Mode**

The most frequent value in a dataset or a particular manner or method of operation.

## **Model**

A simplified representation used to describe, explain, predict, or study a biological or clinical process.

## **Moderator**

A factor that changes the strength or direction of a relationship or treatment effect; it may also mean a person who guides a discussion.

## **Modes Of Inheritance**

Patterns by which genetic traits pass through families, including autosomal dominant, autosomal recessive, X-linked, mitochondrial, and other patterns.

## **Modification**

A change made to a structure, process, treatment, or behavior.

## **Modulator**

A substance or factor that alters the activity of a biological pathway, receptor, gene, or physiological process.

## **Modus Operandi**

The characteristic method by which a person performs an action; it is chiefly a forensic or legal term.

## **Modus Vivendi**

A practical arrangement or way of living that allows people or groups with differences to coexist.

## **Moebius Syndrome**

A congenital disorder characterized mainly by facial paralysis and inability to abduct the eyes, caused by developmental cranial-nerve abnormalities.

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### **Moeller's Glossitis**

An older term for a smooth, painful, inflamed tongue associated especially with nutritional deficiency, including iron, folate, or vitamin B12 deficiency.

### **Moisture**

Water or other liquid present on a surface or in tissue; excessive moisture can cause maceration and skin breakdown.

### **Molar**

Relating to a molar tooth or, in chemistry, to one mole per liter.

### **Molasses**

A viscous syrup produced during sugar refining; it is rich in sugar and may contain variable amounts of minerals.

### **Mold**

A multicellular fungus that grows as branching filaments; molds can cause allergy, food spoilage, or opportunistic infection.

### **Molecular**

Relating to molecules or processes occurring at the molecular level.

### **Molecule**

A group of chemically bonded atoms forming the smallest unit of a substance that retains its chemical properties.

### **Molimina**

The symptoms and physical changes that occur before menstruation, including breast tenderness, bloating, or mood changes.

### **Mollusc**

A soft-bodied invertebrate; the term is also used in names of mollusc-borne or mollusc-associated parasitic diseases.

### **Molluscum Sebaceum**

An obsolete name historically applied to sebaceous-

gland lesions; terminology is inconsistent and the original source should be checked.

### **Molten Metal Fumes**

Fumes produced during welding, smelting, or casting that can cause metal-fume fever, airway irritation, or metal toxicity.

### **Molybdosis**

Illness caused by excessive molybdenum exposure, which may disturb copper metabolism and cause systemic effects.

### **Molybdenum**

An essential trace element required in small amounts for enzymes; excessive exposure can affect copper balance.

### **Moment**

A brief interval or, in biomechanics, the turning effect of a force around a point or joint.

### **Momordica**

A genus of plants including bitter melon; preparations may affect blood glucose and can interact with medicines.

### **Mongol**

An obsolete and offensive term formerly used for a person with Down syndrome; it should not be used clinically.

### **Mongolism**

An obsolete and offensive term for Down syndrome, a chromosomal condition usually caused by trisomy 21.

### **Monoblast**

An immature precursor cell in the monocyte lineage found mainly in bone marrow.

### **Monoclonal Antibodies**

Antibodies produced from a single B-cell clone and directed against one antigenic target; they are used in diagnosis and treatment.

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### **Monocular**

Involving or affecting one eye, or occurring with vision from one eye.

### **Monocytopenia**

An abnormally low number of monocytes in the blood.

### **Monocytosis**

An abnormally increased number of monocytes in the blood.

### **Monogenic**

Caused by a variant in a single gene.

### **Monoplegia**

Paralysis affecting one limb.

### **Monopodium**

A single foot or one-sided foot structure; the term is uncommon and may be used descriptively in developmental anatomy.

### **Monorchidism**

The presence of only one testis, either because the other failed to develop, descended, or was removed.

### **Monosaccharide**

A simple sugar that cannot be hydrolyzed into a smaller carbohydrate, such as glucose or fructose.

### **Monotest**

A rapid heterophile-antibody test historically used to support diagnosis of infectious mononucleosis.

### **Monster**

An obsolete and stigmatizing term for a person or fetus with severe congenital anomalies; modern medical language describes the specific anomalies.

### **Mons Veneris**

The rounded fatty prominence over the pubic bone in front of the external female genitalia.

### **Montenegro Test**

A delayed-type hypersensitivity skin test using *Leishmania* antigen, historically used to indicate exposure to leishmaniasis.

### **Mood**

A sustained emotional state perceived by the person and observed by others.

### **Mood Disorder**

A group of mental disorders characterized primarily by pathological depression, mania, hypomania, or their combination.

### **Morbilli**

The medical or Latin name for measles, an acute contagious viral infection with fever and a characteristic rash.

### **Morbilli Form**

Resembling measles in appearance, especially a rash with widespread maculopapular lesions.

### **Morbus**

A Latin term meaning disease, used in some historical disease names.

### **Mordant**

A substance that helps fix a dye to tissue or a material, used in some histological staining methods.

### **Morgagni's Syndrome**

A historical eponym used inconsistently; in some sources it refers to a combination of obesity, virilism, and diabetes associated with adrenal or endocrine disease.

### **Moribund**

In a dying state or near death.

### **Morton's Metatarsalgia**

Pain in the forefoot beneath the metatarsal heads, caused by pressure or irritation and distinct from Morton neuroma.

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### **Morvan's Disease**

A rare autoimmune neurologic syndrome with severe insomnia, hallucinations, confusion, pain, and peripheral nerve hyperexcitability.

### **Mosquito**

A small blood-feeding insect whose bites may transmit malaria, dengue, West Nile virus, and other infections.

### **Mosquito-Borne**

Transmitted by mosquitoes, usually referring to an infectious disease or parasite.

### **Motor**

Relating to movement or to nerves and pathways that control movement.

### **Motor End-Plate**

The specialized postsynaptic region of a skeletal-muscle fiber at the neuromuscular junction.

### **Motor Neurone Disease**

A group of progressive disorders affecting upper and lower motor neurons, including amyotrophic lateral sclerosis.

### **Motor Neurons**

Nerve cells that transmit signals to skeletal muscle or other effectors to produce movement.

### **Mottled Enamel**

Patchy, discolored, or structurally altered tooth enamel, classically caused by excessive fluoride during tooth development.

### **Mottled Teeth**

Teeth with irregular white, brown, or pitted enamel, often due to dental fluorosis or developmental enamel defects.

### **Mould**

British spelling of mold, a multicellular fungus that grows as branching filaments.

### **Moulage**

A model, cast, or realistic reproduction of a body part or lesion used for teaching, simulation, or forensic documentation.

### **Mountain Sickness**

Illness caused by rapid ascent to high altitude, ranging from acute mountain sickness to life-threatening pulmonary or cerebral edema.

### **Mouth-To-Mouth Resuscitation**

Rescue breathing in which air is delivered from a rescuer to a person who is not breathing normally, usually as part of CPR.

### **Mouth-Wash**

A liquid used to rinse the mouth, freshen breath, or deliver an antiseptic, fluoride, or other active ingredient.

### **Moxibustion**

A traditional therapy involving heat from burning mugwort near or on selected skin points; burns and other adverse effects can occur.

### **MPTP**

A neurotoxin that can produce permanent parkinsonism by damaging dopaminergic neurons in the substantia nigra.

### **Mucilage**

A viscous plant-derived polysaccharide or similar substance that swells in water and may act as a soothing or bulking agent.

### **Mucin**

A glycoprotein forming the principal component of mucus and helping protect epithelial surfaces.

### **Mucoid**

Resembling mucus or containing a mucus-like substance.

### **Mucolytics**

Medicines that reduce the viscosity of mucus and

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facilitate its clearance from the airways.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis**

A group of inherited lysosomal-storage disorders in which glycosaminoglycans accumulate, causing variable skeletal, organ, neurologic, and developmental abnormalities.

### **Mucopus**

Pus mixed with mucus, commonly seen in infected mucous membranes or sinuses.

### **Mucosal**

Relating to a mucous membrane.

### **Mucus**

A slippery secretion containing mucins, water, salts, and cells that protects and lubricates mucous membranes.

### **Mulberry Molars**

Permanent molars with irregular, multiple rounded cusps, classically associated with congenital syphilis.

### **Mule-Spinner's Cancer**

An obsolete occupational term for scrotal squamous-cell cancer associated historically with soot exposure in chimney sweeps and textile workers.

### **Multifactorial**

Caused or influenced by multiple genetic, environmental, behavioral, or other factors.

### **Multigravida**

A person who has been pregnant two or more times, regardless of outcome.

### **Multilocular**

Having many compartments or locules, as in a cyst or lesion.

### **Multiparous**

Having given birth two or more times to a fetus or fetuses beyond the stage of viability.

### **Mural**

Relating to a wall, especially the wall of a body cavity, organ, or blood vessel.

### **Mural Thrombosis**

Formation of a blood clot along the wall of a heart chamber or blood vessel rather than freely within the lumen.

### **Murphy's Sign**

Inspiratory arrest caused by pain when the right upper quadrant is palpated, traditionally suggesting acute cholecystitis.

### **Musca**

A genus of flies, including the housefly; some species can mechanically carry pathogens.

### **Muscae Volitantes**

Moving spots, threads, or cobweb-like shapes seen in the visual field, usually caused by shadows from vitreous opacities.

### **Muscarine**

A mushroom-derived parasympathomimetic toxin that stimulates muscarinic receptors and can cause salivation, sweating, bradycardia, and bronchospasm.

### **Muscle Relaxants**

Medicines that reduce skeletal-muscle spasm or neuromuscular transmission; they include centrally acting drugs and peripheral neuromuscular blockers.

### **Muscle Spasm**

Sudden involuntary contraction of a muscle that may cause pain, stiffness, or abnormal posture.

### **Muscular**

Relating to muscle or composed of muscle tissue.

### **Musculus**

Latin for muscle, used in anatomical names.

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### **Mushroom Poisoning**

Illness caused by eating toxic fungi, with effects ranging from gastrointestinal upset to liver failure, neurologic toxicity, or death.

### **Mussolini's Disease**

An obsolete eponym historically used for a form of peripheral neuropathy; its meaning is inconsistent and should be verified from the original source.

### **Mutism**

Absence or refusal of speech despite adequate ability to speak, occurring in conditions such as catatonia, selective mutism, or neurologic disease.

### **Myasthenic Syndrome**

A disorder of neuromuscular transmission causing fluctuating weakness; it may refer to myasthenia gravis or a congenital or Lambert-Eaton syndrome depending on context.

### **Mycetoma**

A chronic localized infection of skin and subcutaneous tissue caused by fungi or filamentous bacteria, producing swelling, sinuses, and grains.

### **Mycobacterium**

A genus of acid-fast bacteria that includes the causes of tuberculosis and leprosy and several nontuberculous infections.

### **Mycoplasma**

A genus of very small bacteria lacking a cell wall, including organisms that cause respiratory and genitourinary infections.

### **Mycosis**

An infection caused by a fungus.

### **Mycotoxin**

A toxic substance produced by certain fungi, including aflatoxins and ergot alkaloids.

### **Myosis**

Constriction of the pupil.

### **Myositis**

Inflammation of skeletal muscle, caused by autoimmune disease, infection, medicines, or other injury.

### **Myotatic**

Relating to a muscle stretch reflex.

### **Myringotomy**

A small incision in the eardrum, often used to drain middle-ear fluid and insert a ventilation tube.

### **Mammary**

Relating to the breast or mammary gland.

### **Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI)**

A nonionizing imaging technique using magnetic fields and radiofrequency signals to create detailed images of tissues and organs.

### **Myocardial**

Relating to the myocardium, the muscular wall of the heart.

### **Myocardium**

The muscular middle layer of the heart wall that contracts to pump blood.

### **Myoclonus**

A sudden, brief, involuntary muscle jerk or group of jerks.

### **Myodegeneration**

Degeneration or breakdown of muscle fibers, caused by inherited, inflammatory, ischemic, toxic, or other disorders.

### **Myoglobin**

An oxygen-binding protein in skeletal and cardiac muscle; it can enter blood and urine after muscle injury.

### **Myoglobinuria**

Presence of myoglobin in urine, usually due to muscle breakdown such as rhabdomyolysis.



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## **Myoma**

A benign tumor arising from muscle tissue, commonly referring to a uterine leiomyoma.

## **Myomalacia**

Softening or degeneration of muscle tissue, including the heart muscle after severe injury.

## **Myometrium**

The thick smooth-muscle layer of the uterus responsible for contractions during menstruation and labor.

## **Myopathy**

A disease of muscle causing weakness, fatigue, pain, or abnormal muscle enzymes.

## **Myopia**

Short-sightedness, a refractive error in which distant objects focus in front of the retina and appear blurred.

## **Myositis Ossificans**

Formation of mature bone within muscle or other soft tissue, usually after trauma or repeated injury.

## **Myringitis**

Inflammation of the tympanic membrane, sometimes producing painful blisters and associated hearing symptoms.

## **Mianserin**

A tetracyclic antidepressant with noradrenergic and antihistamine effects, used in some countries.

## **Miconazole**

An imidazole antifungal used topically or orally in selected fungal infections.

## **Methyisazone**

Another spelling of methisazone, an older antiviral compound investigated for poxvirus infection.

## **Myel-**

A combining form relating to bone marrow or the spinal cord, depending on the word.

## **Myeloblast**

An immature precursor of granulocytes in the bone marrow; excess myeloblasts are characteristic of acute myeloid leukemia.

## **Myelocyte**

A developing granulocyte precursor in bone marrow that is more mature than a myeloblast and normally absent or rare in peripheral blood.

## **Myelocytic Leukaemia**

Leukemia arising from the myeloid cell line, including acute myeloid and chronic myeloid leukemia.

## **Myeloid**

Relating to bone marrow or to the non-lymphoid blood-cell lineages derived from hematopoietic stem cells.

## **Myelomalacia**

Softening of the spinal cord, usually due to ischemia, trauma, hemorrhage, or other cord injury.

## **Myeloproliferative Disorders**

Clonal bone-marrow disorders causing overproduction of one or more blood-cell lineages, including polycythemia vera, essential thrombocythemia, and myelofibrosis.

## **Myoblast**

An embryonic precursor cell that fuses or differentiates to form skeletal muscle fibers.

## **Myoblastoma**

A rare tumor composed of cells resembling developing muscle; the exact entity depends on the source and modern classification.

### **Synonyms:**

Aerophagia; stomach bubble syndrome

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## Major Depression

A depressive disorder causing persistent low mood or loss of interest with significant functional impairment.

### Synonyms:

Major depressive disorder

## Major Histocompatibility Complex Molecule

A cell-surface molecule that presents protein fragments to immune cells.

### Synonyms:

MHC molecule

## Maladaptive Stress Response

A persistent or disproportionate stress reaction that harms health or functioning.

## Malignant

Cancerous and capable of invading nearby tissue or spreading to distant sites.

## Mastopexy

Surgery that lifts and reshapes sagging breasts.

### Synonyms:

Breast lift

## Meglitinides

Short-acting medicines that stimulate pancreatic insulin release to lower blood glucose.

## Melanin

Melanin is a pigment produced by melanocytes that gives skin, hair, and eyes their colour and absorbs ultraviolet radiation; its amount and distribution influence pigmentation disorders and melanoma biology.

## Melatonin

A hormone produced mainly by the pineal gland that helps regulate sleep-wake timing.

## Membrane

A thin tissue layer that surrounds a cell, organ, or body cavity.

## Memory T Cells And B Cells

Long-lived immune cells that respond rapidly when they encounter a previously recognized antigen.

### Synonyms:

Memory lymphocytes

## MéNièRe's Disease

An inner-ear disorder associated with episodic vertigo, fluctuating hearing loss, tinnitus, and ear pressure.

### Synonyms:

Meniere disease

## Metabolic Equivalents

Units estimating the energy cost of physical activity relative to resting metabolism.

### Synonyms:

METs

## Methanobrevibacter Smithii

A methane-producing microorganism commonly found in the human intestine.

## METs

Metabolic equivalents, units used to express the intensity or energy cost of physical activity.

### Synonyms:

Metabolic equivalents

## MHC Molecule

A major histocompatibility complex molecule that displays antigens to T cells.

### Synonyms:

Major histocompatibility complex molecule

## Microbe

A microorganism, such as a bacterium, fungus, protozoan, or virus.

### Synonyms:

Microorganism

## Microdermabrasion

A cosmetic procedure that mechanically removes a superficial layer of skin.

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### **Micronized**

Processed into very small particles to improve dispersion or absorption.

### **Microvasculature**

The network of the body's smallest blood vessels, including arterioles, capillaries, and venules.

### **Migraine Headache**

A recurrent headache disorder often causing moderate-to-severe pain, nausea, and sensitivity to light or sound.

#### **Synonyms:**

Migraine

### **Miotic**

A substance or medicine that constricts the pupil.

#### **Synonyms:**

Miotic agent

### **Monocytes**

Large circulating white blood cells that can enter tissues and become macrophages or dendritic cells.

### **Morton's Neuroma**

Thickening and irritation of a nerve, usually between the toes, causing burning forefoot pain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Morton neuroma; interdigital neuroma

### **Motilin**

A hormone that helps regulate contractions and movement in the upper gastrointestinal tract.

### **Motility**

The ability of an organ, especially the intestine, to move its contents.

### **Motor Neuron**

A nerve cell that controls skeletal or smooth muscle activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Motor nerve cell

### **Mucosa**

Mucosa is the moist epithelial lining of body passages such as the mouth, nose, airways, gastrointestinal tract, and reproductive or urinary tracts.

### **Mucous Cysts**

Small fluid-filled cysts near the end joint of a finger, often associated with osteoarthritis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Digital mucous cyst

### **Mucous Membrane**

A moist tissue lining body cavities that open to the outside, including the nose, mouth, and lungs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mucosa

### **Multi-Infarct Dementia**

Cognitive decline caused by the cumulative effects of multiple small strokes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular dementia

### **Multinodular Goiter**

An enlarged thyroid containing multiple nodules.

### **Muscle Fatigue**

Reduced ability of a muscle to generate force after sustained or repeated activity.

### **Muscle Fibers**

Individual contractile cells that combine to form skeletal muscle.

#### **Synonyms:**

Muscle cells

### **Muscle-Contraction Headache**

A pressure-like headache related to sustained contraction of scalp, neck, or jaw muscles.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tension-type headache

### **Muscular Endurance**

The ability of a muscle or muscle group to sustain

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repeated or prolonged effort.

### **Muscularis**

A smooth-muscle layer in the wall of a hollow organ, especially the intestine.

#### **Synonyms:**

Muscular layer

### **Musculoskeletal**

Relating to muscles, bones, joints, tendons, ligaments, and related tissues.

### **MUSE**

A medicated urethral system that delivers a pellet into the urethra to treat erectile dysfunction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Medicated urethral system for erection

### **Myalgia**

Muscle pain or tenderness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Myodynia

### **Mydriatic**

A substance or medicine that dilates the pupil.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mydriatic agent

### **Myocyte**

A muscle cell.

#### **Synonyms:**

Muscle cell

### **Myofibrils**

Contractile structures inside muscle fibers made of repeating sarcomeres.

### **Myofilaments**

Actin and myosin protein filaments that slide past each other to produce muscle contraction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Contractile filaments

### **Myosin**

A motor protein that interacts with actin to generate muscle force.

### **Macrobiotics**

Diet emphasizing whole grains, vegetables, beans. May be nutritionally inadequate if restrictive. Long-term followers generally healthy but may have deficiencies.

### **Macrodonia**

Abnormally large teeth. Microdonia: abnormally small teeth.

### **Macroglossia**

Macroglossia is an abnormally enlarged tongue that can affect feeding, speech, airway, or dental development and may be congenital or acquired.

### **Macrolides**

A class of bacteriostatic antibiotics that bind to the 50S ribosomal subunit and inhibit translocation of peptidyl-tRNA during protein synthesis. The major macrolides include erythromycin, clarithromycin, and azithromycin.

### **Macronutrients**

Nutrients needed in large amounts: carbohydrates, protein, fat. Provide energy and structural components.

### **Macrophage Activation Syndrome**

A life-threatening complication of rheumatic diseases (especially systemic JIA and SLE) characterized by uncontrolled cytokine release and hemophagocytosis.

### **Macrosomia**

Macrosomia means unusually large fetal or newborn size, often associated with diabetes, prolonged pregnancy, parental size, or other factors.

### **Macula**

The macula is a specialized region of the central retina approximately five and a half millimeters in

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diameter that is responsible for high-acuity central vision, color perception, and fine detail discrimination, and it contains the highest density of cone photoreceptors in the eye.

### **Macula Lutea**

Small oval yellowish central retinal area approximately 5.5 mm in diameter for high-acuity vision. Yellow color from xanthophyll pigments (lutein, zeaxanthin) filtering blue light and protecting photoreceptors. The fovea centralis is the central depression (1.5 mm) with highest cone density and no rods.

### **Macular**

Relating to a macule, a flat, circumscribed change in skin color without a change in texture or elevation. Macules may be caused by pigment, inflammation, vascular change, or other processes and are distinguished from raised lesions such as papules.

### **Macular Degeneration**

A progressive degenerative disease of the central retina (macula) and the leading cause of irreversible vision loss in individuals over age 50 in developed countries, affecting approximately 10 percent of those over 65 and 30 percent over 80.

#### **Synonyms:**

Age Related Macular Degeneration (Macular Degeneration)

### **Macular Hole**

A full-thickness defect of the fovea usually caused by vitreomacular traction, presenting with central scotoma and distorted or reduced central vision. Staged by OCT; surgical vitrectomy with internal limiting membrane peel restores closure in most cases.

### **Macular Pucker**

An epiretinal membrane of fibrocellular tissue on the inner retinal surface that contracts to distort the macula, causing metamorphopsia and reduced vision. Diagnosed by OCT; vitrectomy with membrane peeling is reserved for visually significant symptoms.

### **Macule**

A macule is a flat, circumscribed change in skin color without palpable elevation or depression.

### **Maffucci Syndrome**

A rare congenital disorder characterized by multiple enchondromas together with soft-tissue hemangiomas or lymphangiomas. Skeletal deformity, limb shortening, pathological fractures, and increased risk of cartilage or other malignancy may occur.

### **MAG3 Renal Scan**

Nuclear medicine scan evaluating renal function and obstruction. Differential function between kidneys. Non-obstructive dilation does not show delayed excretion. Useful for assessing split renal function and planning surgical interventions.

### **Magnesium**

A predominantly intracellular cation that stabilizes ATP, supports hundreds of enzymes, and contributes to neuromuscular transmission, nucleic-acid synthesis, and bone metabolism. Deficiency may cause weakness, tremor, arrhythmias, hypokalemia, or hypocalcemia.

### **Magnesium Deficiency**

An abnormally low body magnesium level, often caused by poor intake, gastrointestinal loss, renal wasting, or medications. It may cause weakness, tremor, muscle cramps, seizures, cardiac arrhythmias, hypokalemia, and hypocalcemia.

### **Magnesium Sulfate For Neuroprotection**

Intravenous magnesium sulfate given in selected cases of imminent very preterm birth to reduce the risk of neurologic injury in the infant. The gestational-age criteria, dose, duration, and monitoring follow local obstetric and neonatal guidance.

### **Magnetic Resonance Angiography**

MRI techniques used to depict arteries or veins, with or without contrast. It may evaluate stenosis, aneurysm, dissection, thrombosis, and vascular malformation without ionizing radiation.

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## **Magnetic Resonance Cholangiopancreatography**

MRI technique visualizing biliary and pancreatic ducts without contrast. Non-invasive alternative to ERCP. Used for choledocholithiasis, biliary strictures, pancreatic pathology.

## **Magnetic Resonance Imaging**

Uses strong magnetic field and radiofrequency pulses to generate images from hydrogen protons. Excellent soft tissue contrast. No ionizing radiation. Sequences: T1-weighted (fat bright, fluid dark), T2-weighted (fluid bright), FLAIR (suppresses CSF), DWI (diffusion restriction). Contrast: gadolinium-based.

## **Magnetic Resonance Safety**

The practices used to prevent injury from the static magnetic field, gradient fields, radiofrequency energy, and implanted or ferromagnetic objects in the MRI environment. Screening must address implants, foreign bodies, devices, pregnancy, burns, hearing protection, and projectile risk.

## **Magnetic Resonance Spectroscopy**

MRI technique measuring metabolic compounds. Used for tumor characterization, metabolic disorders.

## **Magnetic Seed**

Sentinel lymph node localization using magnetic seed. Alternative to radioactive tracer.

## **Magnetic Therapy**

PEMF for bone healing, pain. Evidence mixed.

## **Mahvash Disease**

A rare inherited disorder of glucagon signaling caused by inactivating variants in the glucagon receptor. It may cause pancreatic alpha-cell hyperplasia, enlarged pancreas, abnormal glucose regulation, and elevated circulating glucagon.

## **Maintenance Dose**

The dose of a drug administered at regular intervals

to maintain a desired steady-state concentration, balancing the rate of drug administration with the rate of elimination. The maintenance dose is calculated as: Maintenance dose rate = (Clearance x desired concentration) / Bioavailability.

## **Maintenance Therapy**

Long-term treatment to prevent recurrence. Examples: hormonal therapy, targeted therapy.

## **Major Depressive Disorder**

A mood disorder characterized by at least one major depressive episode consisting of five or more symptoms during the same two-week period. At least one symptom must be either depressed mood or loss of interest or pleasure (anhedonia).

## **Major Histocompatibility Complex**

A locus of highly polymorphic genes encoding cell-surface glycoproteins that present antigen peptides to T cells. Human Leukocyte Antigen (HLA) in humans. MHC Class I (HLA-A, B, C): expressed on all nucleated cells, presents endogenous antigens (viral/tumor) to CD8<sup>+</sup> cytotoxic T cells.

## **Malabsorption**

Malabsorption is impaired digestion or absorption of nutrients in the gastrointestinal tract, causing diarrhea, weight loss, anemia, vitamin deficiency, or bone disease. pancreatic insufficiency, bacterial overgrowth, Crohn disease, short bowel syndrome, and infections. Presents with diarrhea, steatorrhea, weight loss, and deficiency of specific nutrients (iron, B12, vitamin D, calcium).

## **Malacoplakia**

A chronic granulomatous inflammatory reaction characterized by macrophages containing basophilic Michaelis-Gutmann bodies. It most often affects the urinary or gastrointestinal tract and may form mass-like lesions that mimic malignancy.

## **Malaise**

Malaise is a general feeling of illness, discomfort, or lack of well-being that commonly accompanies infection, inflammation, chronic disease, medication



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effects, or other systemic conditions.

### **Malakoplakia**

Rare chronic inflammatory condition characterized by accumulation of macrophages containing calcified inclusion bodies called Michaelis-Gutmann bodies, most commonly affecting the urinary bladder but also occurring in the gastrointestinal tract.

### **Malar Rash**

A red or violaceous rash across the cheeks and bridge of the nose, often sparing the folds beside the nose. It is classically associated with systemic lupus erythematosus but can occur with other conditions; appearance alone does not establish a diagnosis.

### **Malaria**

Malaria is a mosquito-borne infection caused by Plasmodium parasites. It commonly causes cyclical fever, chills, headache, and hemolytic anaemia; severe disease may cause cerebral malaria, respiratory distress, kidney injury, hypoglycaemia, shock, organ failure, or death. Diagnosis and treatment depend on the species, illness severity, and exposure or travel history.

### **Malate Dehydrogenase**

Converts malate to oxaloacetate in TCA cycle. Produces NADH.

### **MALDI-TOF Mass Spectrometry**

Matrix-assisted laser desorption/ionization time-of-flight mass spectrometry, a method that identifies microorganisms by comparing their protein spectral fingerprints with a reference database. It provides rapid identification from an isolated colony and does not by itself establish antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Male Hypoactive Sexual Desire Disorder**

A persistent or recurrent lack of sexual or erotic thoughts and desire in a man that causes personal distress or relationship difficulty. It is distinct from erectile dysfunction, although the conditions may coexist.

### **Male Hypogonadism**

Reduced production of testosterone, impaired sperm production, or both due to disease of the testes or the hypothalamic-pituitary system. Possible features include low libido, erectile difficulty, infertility, reduced muscle mass, fatigue, and loss of bone density.

#### **Synonyms:**

Low Testosterone Testosterone Deficiency

### **Male Infertility**

Reduced ability to achieve a pregnancy because of factors affecting sperm production, sperm transport, ejaculation, sexual function, or other reproductive processes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Infertility, Male

### **Male Menopause**

A nontechnical term sometimes used for age-related decline in testosterone, although it is not equivalent to female menopause. Low testosterone may cause reduced libido, erectile difficulty, fatigue, depressed mood, or loss of muscle mass, but symptoms have many causes and require appropriate hormone testing before treatment.

### **Malignancy**

Malignancy is a cancerous neoplasm capable of invading nearby tissue or spreading to distant sites; diagnosis requires classification of tumor type, grade, stage, and molecular features.

### **Malignant Acanthosis Nigricans**

A paraneoplastic syndrome in which velvety, hyperpigmented, verrucous plaques develop rapidly in flexural and mucosal areas as a marker of an underlying internal malignancy, most commonly gastric adenocarcinoma. Unlike benign acanthosis nigricans, the malignant form is extensive, abrupt in onset, and may involve the oral mucosa.

### **Malignant Ascites**

Intraperitoneal fluid accumulation caused by peritoneal tumor spread, most often ovarian or gastrointestinal cancer. Management includes therapeutic

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paracentesis and, in selected cases, intraperitoneal chemotherapy or shunt placement.

### **Malignant Hypertension**

Severely elevated BP greater than 180/120 with end-organ damage. Renal findings include hyperplastic arteriolosclerosis with onion-skinning and fibrinoid necrosis. Treat with IV antihypertensives. Poor prognosis if untreated. May cause AKI, encephalopathy, and retinopathy.

### **Malignant Hyperthermia**

A rare, life-threatening pharmacogenetic disorder of skeletal muscle triggered by volatile inhalation anesthetics and succinylcholine, with incidence of approximately 1 in 15,000 to 50,000 anesthetics.

### **Malignant Melanoma**

A highly aggressive malignancy arising from melanocytes, characterised by uncontrolled proliferation and potential for early metastasis via lymphatic and haematogenous spread.

### **Malignant Mesothelioma**

A cancer of the mesothelial lining of the pleura (most common), peritoneum, or pericardium. Strongly associated with asbestos exposure, presenting with effusion, chest pain, and dyspnea; prognosis is generally poor.

### **Malignant Neoplasm**

Malignant neoplasms, commonly called cancers, are uncontrolled proliferations of cells that invade surrounding tissues and have the capacity to metastasize to distant sites through lymphatic, hematogenous, or transcoelomic routes.

#### **Synonyms:**

cancers, are uncontrolled proliferations of cells.

### **Malignant Pleural Effusion**

Pleural fluid accumulation from pleural or metastatic disease, causing dyspnea. Managed with thoracentesis, pleurodesis, or an indwelling pleural catheter.

### **Malignant Syphilis**

A severe, destructive form of secondary syphilis presenting with necrotic, gummatous, or ulcerative skin lesions, often in immunocompromised patients, particularly those with HIV co-infection. It represents an aberrant immune response to heavy *Treponema pallidum* infection and requires aggressive intravenous penicillin therapy.

### **Malignant Tumor**

A cancerous growth capable of invading nearby tissue or spreading to distant sites. Its behavior and treatment depend on its type, grade, stage, and molecular features.

### **Malingering**

The intentional fabrication or exaggeration of physical or psychological symptoms for external incentives (avoiding work, obtaining financial compensation, evading criminal prosecution, obtaining drugs). Not a psychiatric illness (coded as a V-code/Z-code).

### **Mallampati Classification**

A simple scoring system used to predict the ease of endotracheal intubation based on the anatomical structures visible in the oral cavity when the patient opens their mouth wide and protrudes their tongue without phonating. Class I: soft palate, fauces, uvula, and tonsillar pillars visible.

### **Malleus**

The largest of the three ossicles in the middle ear.

**Common name:** Hammer

### **Mallory-Weiss Tear**

Longitudinal mucosal laceration at the gastroesophageal junction caused by forceful vomiting or retching. It typically presents with hematemesis. Most bleeds spontaneously within twenty-four to forty-eight hours. Diagnosis is made by upper endoscopy showing a linear mucosal tear.

### **Malnutrition**

Malnutrition includes inadequate, excessive, or imbalanced nutrient intake and can impair growth,

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immunity, wound healing, muscle function, and organ reserve. form, and function. Undernutrition: protein-energy malnutrition, micronutrient deficiencies. Overnutrition: overweight, obesity, related comorbidities. Screen with MNA (Mini Nutritional Assessment), MUST (Malnutrition Universal Screening Tool).

### **Malocclusion**

Misalignment of teeth or incorrect relation between dental arches. Types: Class I (normal molar relationship, crowding), Class II (retrognathic mandible), Class III (prognathic mandible).

### **Malpresentation**

A fetal presentation other than the usual vertex presentation, including breech, face, brow, shoulder, or compound presentation. It may complicate labor and influence delivery planning.

### **Malrotation**

Abnormal rotation or fixation of an organ during development, most often referring to abnormal rotation of the intestine and its risk of volvulus.

### **Maltol**

A flavoring compound used in some foods and medicines to provide a sweet, caramel-like odor or taste.

### **Mammary Gland**

Modified sweat (apocrine) gland in the breast, overlying pectoralis major, with 15-20 lactiferous ducts converging on the nipple. Composed of glandular lobules (alveoli), fibrous stroma (Cooper's ligaments), and fat. Development regulated by estrogen, progesterone, prolactin, and oxytocin (milk let-down).

### **Mastalgia**

Breast pain or tenderness, which may be cyclical with menstruation or noncyclical. Causes include hormonal changes, cysts, infection, trauma, and musculoskeletal pain.

### **Mammary Implant**

Breast augmentation/reconstruction device. Types: saline (silicone shell, saline fill), silicone gel (cohesive gel). Incisions: inframammary, periareolar, axillary. Placement: subglandular or submuscular. Complications: capsular contracture, rupture, infection, BIA-ALCL (anaplastic large cell lymphoma).

### **Mammogram**

A mammogram is a low-dose x-ray examination of breast tissue used for screening and evaluation of masses, asymmetry, calcifications, or other abnormalities.

### **Mammography**

X-ray imaging of the breast used to screen for or evaluate breast abnormalities. Screening intervals depend on age, risk, symptoms, and the guideline being followed. Standard views include the cranio-caudal and mediolateral-oblique projections.

### **Mandible**

Largest facial bone forming the lower jaw, with horseshoe-shaped body and two rami ending in condylar (TMJ) and coronoid processes. Mental foramen transmits the mental nerve. Mandibular foramen is the entry point for inferior alveolar nerve blocks. Most commonly fractured facial bone, typically at the condyle, angle, or symphysis.

### **Mandibular Fracture**

A break in the lower jaw bone typically caused by trauma, presenting with pain, swelling, malocclusion, and difficulty opening the mouth; may require surgical fixation.

### **Manganese**

An essential trace element required in small amounts. Excessive exposure, especially by inhalation, can injure the nervous system and cause manganism, a movement disorder resembling parkinsonism.

### **Mania**

A distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased goal-directed activity or energy, lasting  $\geq 1$  week (or any duration

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if hospitalization required).

### **Manic Episode**

A distinct period lasting at least seven days (or any duration if hospitalization is required) of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy or activity.

### **Manifestation**

A sign, symptom, or other observable expression of a disease or condition.

### **Mannitol**

An osmotic diuretic that is freely filtered at the glomerulus but not reabsorbed, increasing tubular osmotic pressure and water excretion. Used to reduce intracranial pressure (cerebral edema) and intraocular pressure (acute glaucoma), and to promote diuresis in rhabdomyolysis/contrast nephropathy prophylaxis.

### **Mannose-Binding Lectin Deficiency**

An inherited or acquired deficiency of mannose-binding lectin, a protein that activates the lectin pathway of complement. It may increase susceptibility to infection in selected people, especially when other immune defenses are impaired.

### **Mantle Cell Lymphoma**

An aggressive B-cell lymphoma characterized by t(11;14) translocation leading to cyclin D1 overexpression and CCND1-IGH fusion. Clinical: older males, widespread lymphadenopathy, splenomegaly, GI involvement (lymphomatous polyposis), bone marrow, peripheral blood (leukemic phase).

### **Manual Removal Of Placenta**

A procedure in which a clinician removes a placenta that has not separated or cannot be delivered after birth. The timing and need depend on bleeding, maternal condition, and local clinical protocols.

### **MAOIs**

Monoamine oxidase inhibitors are a class of antidepressant drugs that inhibit the enzyme monoamine

oxidase, which breaks down serotonin, norepinephrine, and dopamine in the brain. By inhibiting this enzyme, MAOIs increase the levels of these neurotransmitters in the synaptic cleft.

### **Maple Syrup Urine Disease**

An autosomal recessive inborn error of branched-chain amino acid metabolism caused by deficiency of the branched-chain alpha-ketoacid dehydrogenase complex (BCKDC) — mutations in BCKDHA, BCKDHB, DBT, or DLD.

### **Marasmus**

A severe form of protein-energy malnutrition (PEM) resulting from chronic total calorie and protein deprivation (starvation). Clinical features include severe muscle wasting, loss of subcutaneous fat ("skin and bones" appearance), stunted growth, a "monkey-like" facial appearance, and alertness.

### **Maraviroc**

A CCR5 antagonist (entry inhibitor) used in combination antiretroviral therapy for HIV-1 infection in patients with CCR5-tropic virus. Maraviroc binds to the human CCR5 coreceptor on CD4+ T cells, preventing HIV-1 gp120 binding and viral entry.

### **Marfan Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant connective tissue disorder caused by mutations in the FBN1 gene (fibrillin-1). Cardiovascular manifestations include aortic root dilation and dissection, mitral valve prolapse, and aortic regurgitation. Skeletal features include tall stature, arachnodactyly, pectus deformity, and joint hypermobility.

### **Marfanoid Habitus**

A body habitus characterized by tall stature, long limbs, long fingers (arachnodactyly), and joint laxity. Seen in Marfan syndrome, but also in other connective tissue disorders and homocystinuria. Differentiated from Marfan syndrome by absence of aortic root dilation and lens subluxation.

### **Marfan's Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant connective tissue disorder

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caused by mutations in the FBN1 gene encoding fibrillin-1. Neurological manifestations include dural ectasia (widening of the dural sac, causing back pain and headaches), spontaneous intracranial hypotension from CSF leaks, and increased risk of stroke from arterial dissection.

### **Marrow Hyperplasia**

Increased cellularity of the bone marrow due to accelerated production of blood cells, typically seen as a compensatory response to chronic hemolysis, hemorrhage, or hypoxia.

### **Mass Casualty Incident**

Event overwhelming available resources, requiring triage and resource allocation. Triage systems: START (Simple Triage and Rapid Treatment), SALT. Categories: immediate (red), delayed (yellow), minor (green), expectant (black). Incident command system (ICS) coordinates response.

### **Masseter Muscle**

Thick rectangular muscle of mastication on the mandibular ramus, from the zygomatic arch to mandibular angle/ramus. Innervated by the masseteric nerve (V3). Most powerful masticatory muscle, elevating the mandible with up to 70 kg force. Involved in bruxism, TM disorders, and myofascial pain. Hypertrophy can widen facial appearance.

### **Massive Hemoptysis**

Life-threatening coughing of blood that threatens the airway, breathing, or circulation; a fixed volume threshold is not required. It requires urgent airway assessment, stabilization, and definitive treatment of the bleeding source.

### **Massive Transfusion Protocol**

A coordinated protocol for life-threatening hemorrhage that provides rapid, balanced delivery of red cells, plasma, and platelets with monitoring and correction of fibrinogen, calcium, temperature, and acid-base abnormalities.

### **Mast Cell**

A tissue-resident immune cell with large granules

containing histamine, heparin, tryptase, and cytokines; bears high-affinity IgE receptors (Fc-epsilon-RI).

### **Mast Cell Activation Syndrome**

A condition involving recurrent symptoms from inappropriate release of mast-cell mediators, such as flushing, itching, hives, abdominal symptoms, wheezing, or low blood pressure. Diagnosis requires compatible episodes, objective evidence of mediator release, and response to appropriate treatment; many similar conditions must be excluded.

### **Mastectomy**

Mastectomy examines mastectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. areola, and nipple. Modified radical mastectomy (MRM): total mastectomy + axillary lymph node dissection (levels I-III), for invasive breast cancer.

### **Mastitis**

Inflammation of breast tissue, often occurring during lactation but also possible outside lactation. It may cause localized pain, warmth, swelling, and fever; infection and inflammatory causes must be distinguished clinically.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lactation Mastitis

### **Mastocytosis**

A clonal disorder in which abnormal mast cells accumulate in the skin or internal organs. Cutaneous disease commonly causes urticaria pigmentosa: tan-brown macules or papules that swell and itch after rubbing (Darier sign).

### **Mastoidectomy**

Mastoidectomy examines mastoidectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. from the mastoid portion of the temporal bone, performed for chronic otitis media with cholesteatoma, mastoiditis, or as a component of surgery for acoustic neuroma and other skull base tumors.



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## **Mastoiditis**

Mastoiditis is infection and inflammation of the mastoid air cells behind the ear, usually following middle-ear infection and potentially causing serious spread.

## **Masturbation**

Self-stimulation of the genitals for sexual pleasure. It is a common human behavior; it is generally not harmful unless it causes injury, distress, or interferes with daily life.

### **Synonyms:**

Self Gratification Sexual (Masturbation)

## **Maternal Physiologic Changes In Pregnancy**

Extensive adaptive changes across all organ systems to support the growing fetus.

## **Maternal Pushing (Second Stage)**

Maternal expulsive efforts during the second stage of labor to facilitate fetal descent. Directed (closed-glottis, Valsalva) pushing: sustained breath-hold for 10 seconds with three pushes per contraction. Spontaneous (open-glottis) pushing: shorter pushes with the mother pushing when she feels an urge.

### **Synonyms:**

Second Stage

## **Maternal Sepsis**

Organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated maternal response to infection during pregnancy, childbirth, or the postpartum period. It may arise from uterine, urinary, respiratory, wound, or other infection and requires prompt cultures, antimicrobial therapy, source control, and hemodynamic support.

## **Maturity Onset Diabetes Of The Young**

A monogenic form of diabetes with autosomal dominant inheritance, typically presenting before age 25 with non-insulin-dependent hyperglycemia. Caused by mutations in transcription factors or enzymes of beta-cell function.

## **Maxilla**

Paired bone forming the upper jaw, central face, and parts of orbit, nasal cavity, and hard palate. Body contains the maxillary sinus (largest paranasal sinus). Four processes: frontal, zygomatic, alveolar (upper teeth), and palatine (anterior hard palate). Fractures classified using the Le Fort system.

## **Maxillofacial Prosthesis**

Artificial replacement of maxillofacial structures. Obturator for cleft palate or surgical defect. Ocular, nasal, auricular prostheses.

## **Maximum Plasma Concentration (Cmax)**

The highest measured plasma concentration after a dose. Cmax and the time to reach it are used to describe absorption rate, peak-related toxicity, and comparative pharmacokinetics.

### **Synonyms:**

Cmax

## **Maximum Tolerated Dose**

The highest dose of a drug that produces acceptable, manageable toxicity without causing unacceptable adverse effects, determined through dose-escalation studies, most commonly in Phase I clinical trials. The MTD identifies the dose range for subsequent efficacy studies.

## **May-Thurner Syndrome**

Compression of left common iliac vein by right common iliac artery. Causes left lower extremity DVT. Diagnosis: CT/MR venography, phlebography. Treatment: angioplasty and stenting.

## **MCA Peak Systolic Velocity**

Doppler measurement of the peak systolic velocity in the fetal middle cerebral artery. An indicator of fetal anemia: elevated MCA PSV (>1.5 MoM) correlates with moderate-to-severe anemia. The most important application is surveillance of Rh-sensitized pregnancies (detect anemia before hydrops develops).



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### **McCune-Albright Syndrome**

Sporadic condition caused by activating mutations in the GNAS1 gene encoding the Gs alpha subunit leading to constitutive activation of adenylyl cyclase.

### **McDonald Cerclage**

A transvaginal cervical cerclage using a purse-string suture (Mersilene tape or Prolene) placed at the cervicovaginal junction, without bladder dissection. The most common cerclage technique. Indications: cervical insufficiency (history-indicated or ultrasound-indicated short cervix <25 mm before 24 weeks). Placed at 12-14 weeks.

### **McMurray Test**

A knee examination in which the leg is flexed, rotated, and extended to place stress on the menisci. Pain or a palpable click may suggest a meniscal lesion but is not diagnostic alone.

### **McRoberts Maneuver**

A positioning maneuver for managing shoulder dystocia where the mother's legs are hyperflexed onto her abdomen, with thighs against the abdomen. This flattens the sacrum, increases the anteroposterior diameter of the pelvis, and rotates the symphysis pubis superiorly. Often combined with suprapubic pressure.

### **Mean Arterial Pressure**

The average pressure driving systemic blood flow during one cardiac cycle. It is influenced by cardiac output and systemic vascular resistance and is approximated clinically as diastolic pressure plus one-third of pulse pressure at normal heart rates.

### **Mean Corpuscular Hemoglobin Concentration**

The mean concentration of hemoglobin within packed erythrocytes, calculated from hemoglobin and hematocrit. A reduced MCHC indicates hypochromia; an increased value may occur with spherocytosis or analytical interference.

### **Mean Corpuscular Volume**

The average volume of an erythrocyte, reported

in femtoliters as part of the CBC. A low MCV indicates microcytosis, whereas a high MCV indicates macrocytosis; interpretation requires correlation with hemoglobin, reticulocytes, and other indices.

### **Measles**

Measles is a highly contagious measles-virus infection causing fever, cough, conjunctivitis, and a spreading maculopapular rash, with possible pneumonia, encephalitis, or other complications. droplets. Prodrome of fever, coryza, cough, and conjunctivitis, followed by Koplik spots (white buccal mucosal lesions) and maculopapular rash spreading cephalocaudally. Complications: pneumonia, encephalitis, and subacute sclerosing panencephalitis.

### **Measles Virus**

A negative-sense RNA virus that causes measles, a highly contagious respiratory illness. The virus is transmitted by respiratory droplets and is one of the most infectious pathogens known. Symptoms include fever, cough, coryza, conjunctivitis, and rash.

### **Measles-Rubella Vaccine**

A combined live attenuated vaccine containing measles and rubella antigens without the mumps component, widely used in countries where mumps is not a significant public health burden, including India's Universal Immunization Schedule.

### **Measurable Residual Disease**

The burden of cancer remaining after therapy that can be quantified using a validated assay. The term is increasingly preferred to minimal residual disease because residual disease may be clinically important even when not minimal.

### **Meatuses**

The nasal meatuses are the air passages located beneath each corresponding turbinate on the lateral wall of the nasal cavity, and they serve as the drainage pathways for the paranasal sinuses and the nasolacrimal duct.

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## **Mebrofenin Scan**

Hepatobiliary imaging using Tc-99m mebrofenin. Evaluates liver function, biliary obstruction.

## **Mechanical Circulatory Support**

Devices that provide temporary or permanent cardiac support. Options include intra-aortic balloon pump (IABP), Impella (percutaneous ventricular assist device), TandemHeart, extracorporeal membrane oxygenation (ECMO), and durable left ventricular assist devices (LVADs).

## **Mechanical Insufflation-Exsufflation**

A device that delivers positive pressure (insufflation) followed by rapid negative pressure (exsufflation) to simulate a cough. It is used in neuromuscular disease (Duchenne muscular dystrophy, spinal cord injury, ALS) to augment cough effectiveness and clear secretions.

## **Mechanical Ventilation**

Mechanical ventilation provides respiratory support by delivering controlled or spontaneous breaths through an endotracheal tube or tracheostomy.

## **Mechanism Of Death**

The physiologic or biochemical derangement that causes death (the final failure) as opposed to the underlying disease or injury (cause of death) and the circumstances (manner). Examples: ventricular fibrillation, cerebral hemorrhage, sepsis, respiratory failure, exsanguination, cardiac tamponade.

## **Mechanism Of Toxicity**

How substance causes harm. Examples: enzyme inhibition, membrane disruption, receptor binding, oxidative stress, DNA damage.

## **Meckel Diverticulum**

Congenital remnant of the omphalomesenteric duct located on the antimesenteric border of the distal ileum approximately sixty centimeters from the ileocecal valve.

## **Meconium Aspiration**

Meconium aspiration syndrome (MAS): aspiration of meconium-stained amniotic fluid into the fetal/neonatal airway causing airway obstruction, chemical pneumonitis, and surfactant dysfunction—respiratory distress in term/post-term infants. Risk: fetal distress/hypoxia (passage of meconium in utero).

## **Meconium Aspiration Syndrome**

Respiratory distress in newborns born through meconium-stained amniotic fluid, caused by aspiration of meconium into the airways. Presents with respiratory distress, barrel-shaped chest, and coarse crackles. Meconium is thick, greenish-black fetal stool passed in utero. Risk factors include post-term pregnancy and fetal distress.

## **Meconium Ileus**

Intestinal obstruction in neonates caused by inspissated meconium most commonly associated with cystic fibrosis. Presents with abdominal distension, bilious vomiting, and failure to pass meconium within forty-eight hours.

## **Meconium Peritonitis**

Sterile chemical peritonitis resulting from in utero intestinal perforation allowing meconium to spill into the peritoneal cavity. Most commonly associated with cystic fibrosis causing inspissated meconium obstruction, intestinal atresia, and volvulus. May be detected prenatally as fetal ascites with echogenic peritoneal calcifications.

## **Meconium-Stained Amniotic Fluid**

Greenish or yellowish discoloration of amniotic fluid due to fetal meconium passage in utero. Associated with fetal distress, post-term pregnancy, and fetal growth restriction. Thick meconium increases risk of meconium aspiration syndrome. Management of non-vigorous newborns: tracheal suctioning before positive pressure ventilation.

## **Medial**

Medial means toward or situated nearer the body's midline; it contrasts with lateral and is used to

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describe anatomical position, movement, or imaging findings.

### **Medial Collateral Ligament Injury**

Tear of the MCL, the most common knee ligament injury. Mechanism: valgus stress to the knee (direct blow to lateral knee). Presents with medial knee pain, swelling, and valgus laxity. Grading: I (pain, no laxity), II (partial tear, some laxity), III (complete tear, significant laxity).

### **Medial Cuneiform**

Largest cuneiform, on the medial foot between navicular and first metatarsal. Insertion for tibialis anterior and posterior tendons supporting the medial longitudinal arch. The first tarsometatarsal joint (Lisfranc joint) is an important landmark; Lisfranc injuries involve fracture-dislocation at this level.

### **Medial Rotation**

Rotation of a limb toward the median plane of the body.

### **Median Nerve**

From lateral and medial cords (C5-T1), passing through the arm without branching, through the cubital fossa, into the forearm innervating most flexor muscles. In the hand innervates thenar muscles (opponens, abductor brevis, flexor brevis pollicis) and first two lumbricals. Sensation to lateral 3.5 digits.

### **Median Plane**

A sagittal plane that passes directly through the midline of the body, dividing it into equal right and left halves.

### **Median Rhomboid Glossitis**

A smooth, red, diamond-shaped depapillated area on the dorsum of the tongue caused by chronic *Candida* infection, usually asymptomatic and managed with antifungal therapy.

### **Median Survival**

The time by which half of the people in a study

have experienced the specified event, such as death. It is a summary measure of survival in a defined population.

### **Mediastinitis**

Mediastinitis is inflammation or infection of the central chest compartment, often after esophageal rupture, surgery, trauma, or spread of infection.

### **Mediastinoscopy**

A surgical procedure that accesses the mediastinum through a small incision near the sternum to inspect or biopsy mediastinal lymph nodes or masses. It is one option for staging lung cancer when less-invasive sampling is nondiagnostic or unsuitable.

### **Mediastinum**

The central compartment of the thoracic cavity between the lungs, containing the heart, major blood vessels, esophagus, and trachea.

### **Mediators Of Inflammation**

Inflammatory mediators are soluble molecules that initiate, amplify, or regulate the inflammatory response.

### **Medical Cannabis And Cannabidiol**

Cannabis (marijuana) and cannabidiol (CBD) are cannabinoid compounds derived from *Cannabis sativa* that interact with the endocannabinoid system (CB1 and CB2 receptors) to modulate pain, appetite, mood, and inflammation.

### **Medical Condition**

A state affecting health or bodily function, whether acute, chronic, symptomatic, or asymptomatic.

### **Medical Ethics**

Moral principles guiding healthcare practice, including autonomy, beneficence, non-maleficence, and justice.

### **Medical Examiner**

An appointed physician, usually a board-certified forensic pathologist, charged with investigating sud-

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den, unexpected, violent, or suspicious deaths, ordering autopsies, determining cause and manner of death, and certifying the death certificate. Unlike the elected coroner, a medical examiner must meet professional qualifications.

### **Medical Illness**

The subjective experience of being unwell, which may or may not correspond to an identifiable disease.

### **Medical Jargon**

Specialized terminology used by healthcare professionals. Unexplained medical jargon can hinder communication with patients.

### **Medical Jurisprudence**

The branch of law (and its study) that deals with the rights and duties of physicians and the legal aspects of medical practice, distinct from but overlapping with forensic medicine.

### **Medical Negligence (Malpractice)**

Legal tort occurring when a healthcare provider fails to exercise the standard of reasonable care, skill, or diligence expected of a prudent practitioner of similar standing, resulting in injury, harm, or death to a patient.

#### **Synonyms:**

Malpractice

### **Medical Nutrition Therapy**

Individualized nutrition intervention by registered dietitian. Conditions: diabetes, renal disease, GI disorders, cancer, obesity.

### **Medical Physicist**

Expert in radiation physics and safety.

### **Medical Physics**

The application of physics to medicine, including diagnostic imaging, radiation therapy, radiation safety, and physiological measurement.

### **Medical Privacy**

Protection of identifiable patient information and control of its disclosure in healthcare.

### **Medical Records**

A documented account of a patient's clinical history, examination, investigations, treatment, and outcome maintained by providers. In medicolegal practice, records are contemporaneous evidence in malpractice, injury, criminal, and death cases, so accuracy, timeliness, and unaltered amendments are essential.

### **Medical Tattooing**

Medical tattooing (permanent makeup, micropigmentation) covers depigmented skin (vitiligo, vitiligo camouflage), restores areolas after mastectomy, and masks scars. Trichopigmentation simulates hair on bald scalp. Medical tattooing uses specialized pigments and techniques.

### **Medical Tests**

Diagnostic procedures used to screen for, confirm, or monitor disease through analysis of biologic specimens, imaging, physiologic measurements, or genetic material.

### **Medication Adherence**

The extent to which a patient's medication-taking behavior corresponds with the agreed treatment plan. Adherence is influenced by understanding, adverse effects, cost, access, regimen complexity, beliefs, and cognitive or social factors.

### **Medication Adverse-Effect Profile**

The clinically relevant pattern of predictable pharmacologic effects and harmful reactions associated with a medication. It includes common dose-related effects, serious rare events, organ-specific toxicity, interactions, and monitoring requirements.

### **Medication Cascade**

A prescribing sequence in which an adverse drug effect is misinterpreted as a new medical condition and another drug is prescribed to treat it. Recognizing cascades is an important goal of medication

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reconciliation and deprescribing.

### **Medication Deprescribing**

A planned, supervised process of reducing the dose or stopping a medicine when its current or future harms outweigh its benefits or when treatment goals change. Tapering may be required to prevent withdrawal or rebound disease.

### **Medication Error**

A preventable event that may cause or lead to inappropriate medication use or patient harm while the medication is in the control of a healthcare professional, patient, or consumer. Errors can occur during prescribing, transcribing, dispensing, administration, or monitoring.

### **Medication Management**

The systematic process of optimizing pharmacotherapy to achieve therapeutic goals while minimizing adverse effects, encompassing prescribing, dispensing, administration, monitoring, and deprescribing.

### **Medication Reconciliation**

A structured process of obtaining and comparing the most accurate medication list with current prescriptions at transitions of care. It identifies omissions, duplications, incorrect doses, interactions, and unintended changes.

### **Medication Review**

Systematic examination of all medications for appropriateness. Components: indication, efficacy, safety, adherence, interactions. Tools: Beers Criteria, STOPP/START. Goals: deprescribing, optimizing therapy, reducing adverse effects.

### **Medication Safety**

Practices that reduce medication errors and prevent avoidable harm during prescribing, dispensing, administration, and use.

### **Medication Side Effects**

Unintended harmful responses to medications occurring at standard doses, ranging from mild (nausea,

rash, dry mouth) to severe (anaphylaxis, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, QT prolongation, hepatotoxicity).

### **Medications And Treatments**

all pharmacologic and therapeutic interventions used to prevent, manage, or cure disease, classified by mechanism of action, therapeutic class, and route of administration.

### **Medicolegal**

Pertaining to the application of medical knowledge to legal questions and the intersection of medicine and the law. Covers forensic pathology, toxicology, psychiatry, and clinical issues: informed consent, malpractice, medical records, disability, personal injury, occupational disease, and public health law.

### **Mediterranean Diet**

Traditional eating pattern of Greece, Southern Italy. Emphasizes: fruits, vegetables, whole grains, legumes, nuts, olive oil, moderate fish/poultry, limited red meat. Associated with reduced cardiovascular disease, diabetes, cognitive decline.

### **Medulla Oblongata**

Most inferior brainstem segment, continuous with the spinal cord at the foramen magnum. Contains vital autonomic centers: cardiovascular center (heart rate, blood pressure), respiratory center (dorsal/ventral respiratory groups), and area postrema (vomiting center).

### **Medullary Sponge Kidney**

Congenital malformation characterized by cystic dilatation of the collecting ducts in the renal papillae predisposing to nephrolithiasis and nephrocalcinosis. Presents with recurrent kidney stones, hematuria, and urinary tract infections.

### **Medullary Thyroid Carcinoma**

Neuroendocrine tumor arising from parafollicular C cells that produce calcitonin. Accounts for approximately five percent of thyroid carcinomas. May be sporadic or hereditary as part of multiple endocrine neoplasia type two A or two B. Serum calcitonin



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serves as a tumor marker. Diagnosis requires FNA with calcitonin immunohistochemistry.

### **Medulloblastoma**

A fast-growing embryonal tumor of the cerebellum and the most common malignant brain tumor of childhood. Treated with surgical resection, craniospinal radiation, and chemotherapy.

### **Meige Syndrome**

A segmental cranial dystonia characterized by involuntary bilateral blepharospasm with dystonic contractions of the lower face, jaw, or tongue. Symptoms fluctuate and may be worsened by stress, speech, chewing, or sensory stimuli.

### **Meigs Syndrome**

The triad of benign ovarian fibroma, ascites, and pleural effusion. The effusions typically resolve after removal of the ovarian tumour and should be distinguished from malignant ovarian disease.

### **Meiosis**

A specialized cell division that produces haploid eggs or sperm from a diploid precursor cell and creates genetic variation through recombination and chromosome assortment.

### **Melancholic Features**

A specifier for major depressive episodes characterized by a loss of interest or pleasure in all or almost all activities, a depressed mood that is qualitatively distinct from grief, prominent psychomotor retardation or agitation, significant anorexia or weight loss, excessive guilt, and worsening of mood in the morning.

### **Melanocytes**

Dendritic pigment-producing neural crest-derived cells in the epidermal basal layer and hair follicles, comprising approximately 5-10 percent of basal keratinocytes. Produce melanin (eumelanin, brown-black; pheomelanin, yellow-red) in melanosomes, transferred to keratinocytes via dendritic processes for UV protection.

### **Melanoma**

Melanoma is a malignant tumor of melanocytes, most often arising in skin but also in eye or mucosal sites; early detection matters because it can invade and metastasize.

#### **Synonyms:**

Malignant Melanoma (Melanoma) Skin Cancer, Melanoma

### **Melanoma Surveillance**

regular skin examination, patient education on self-examination, and dermoscopic monitoring of atypical nevi. High-risk patients (personal or family history, numerous atypical nevi, immunosuppression) require 6-month follow-up. Standard patients require annual examination. Total body photography establishes baseline for change detection.

### **Melanoma Treatment**

Stage-dependent. Stage 0 to IA: wide local excision. Stage IB to IIA: wide excision with sentinel lymph node biopsy. Stage IIB to IIC: wide excision, SLNB, and adjuvant therapy.

### **Melasma**

Melasma is acquired, usually symmetric brown or gray facial hyperpigmentation associated with ultraviolet exposure, hormones, pregnancy, and genetic susceptibility; it is benign but often recurrent.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chloasma (Melasma)

### **Melasma (Chloasma)**

An acquired, chronic pigmentary disorder characterized by symmetric, hyperpigmented, light-to-dark brown macules and patches on sun-exposed areas of the face (malar, forehead, upper lip, chin). It primarily affects women of childbearing age and individuals with darker skin types (Fitzpatrick types III-V).

#### **Synonyms:**

Chloasma

### **Melatonin Receptor Agonists**

Medications that act on MT1 and MT2 receptors in



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the suprachiasmatic nucleus to regulate circadian rhythms. Ramelteon is approved for insomnia with sleep onset difficulty. It has no abuse potential and does not cause dependence. It is a useful alternative to benzodiazepines for sleep initiation problems.

### **MELD Score**

Model for End-Stage Liver Disease predicting three-month mortality in advanced liver disease used for liver transplant allocation. The score is calculated using serum bilirubin, creatinine, and international normalized ratio generating a continuous score from approximately six to forty points.

### **Melioidosis**

An infectious disease caused by *Burkholderia pseudomallei*, usually acquired from contaminated soil or water through inoculation or inhalation. It may cause pneumonia, skin infection, abscesses, sepsis, or chronic disease and is more severe in people with diabetes or other risk factors.

### **Melorheostosis**

A rare sclerosing bone dysplasia producing irregular, flowing cortical hyperostosis on imaging. It may cause pain, stiffness, limb deformity, restricted movement, contractures, or soft-tissue fibrosis and can affect one or several contiguous bones.

### **Memantine**

An NMDA receptor antagonist (uncompetitive, low-to-moderate affinity) used for moderate to severe Alzheimer disease, often added to an acetylcholinesterase inhibitor. Blocks excessive glutamate-mediated excitotoxicity while preserving normal synaptic transmission. Once or twice daily oral.

### **Membrane Potential**

The electrical potential difference across a cell membrane, approximately -70 mV in most neurons (resting membrane potential). Established by the unequal distribution of ions (primarily K<sup>+</sup>, Na<sup>+</sup>, Cl<sup>-</sup>) across the membrane and selective permeability.

### **Membranoproliferative**

### **Glomerulonephritis**

Pattern of glomerular injury with mesangial proliferation and capillary wall thickening creating tram-track appearance on silver stain. Hepatitis C is common cause of immune complex MPGN. C3 glomerulopathy represents complement-mediated disease. Associated with monoclonal gammopathies.

### **Membranous Nephropathy**

A glomerular disease caused by immune-complex deposition along the glomerular basement membrane. It commonly causes proteinuria and nephrotic syndrome and may be primary or secondary to another disease, medication, or infection.

### **Memory**

The cognitive process of encoding, storing, and retrieving information, mediated by distributed neural networks involving the hippocampus, medial temporal lobe, prefrontal cortex, and limbic system.

### **Memory Cell**

Long-lived lymphocytes (memory B cells and memory T cells) that survive after an immune response and mount rapid, enhanced responses to re-exposure to the same antigen (immunological memory).

### **Memory Loss**

Reduced ability to recall or learn information. It may result from normal aging, medical illness, medicines, brain injury, or a neurocognitive disorder.

### **Memory Loss (Amnesia)**

Reduced ability to recall past information, form new memories, or both. Causes include normal aging, medications, head injury, seizures, stroke, infection, substance use, neurocognitive disorders, and psychological conditions; sudden memory loss requires urgent assessment.

### **Nausea And Vomiting During Early Pregnancy**

Nausea and vomiting are common in early pregnancy, but persistent symptoms with inability to keep fluids down, weight loss, dehydration, abdom-

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inal pain, fever, blood, or altered mental status may indicate hyperemesis gravidarum or another condition and require medical evaluation.

### **Mendelson Syndrome**

A chemical pneumonitis caused by inhalation of acidic stomach contents, classically during anesthesia or childbirth. It can cause cough, breathing difficulty, and impaired oxygenation.

### **Meniere Disease**

An inner ear disorder characterized by recurrent episodes of vertigo lasting 20 minutes to 12 hours, with fluctuating sensorineural hearing loss, tinnitus, and aural fullness. Due to endolymphatic hydrops. Diagnosis: clinical criteria; audiometry shows low-frequency SNHL during attacks.

#### **Synonyms:**

Menieres Disease (Meniere Disease)

### **Meninges**

The three membranes enveloping the brain and spinal cord: dura mater (outermost, tough), arachnoid mater (middle, avascular), and pia mater (innermost, adherent to the CNS surface). The subarachnoid space (between arachnoid and pia) contains cerebrospinal fluid. The epidural and subdural spaces are sites of hemorrhage.

### **Motor Vehicle Accident**

A collision or other road-traffic event causing injury or property damage. Medical evaluation may be needed for visible or delayed injuries, including head, neck, chest, abdominal, or musculoskeletal trauma.

### **Meningioma**

A usually slow-growing tumor arising from cells associated with the meninges. Most are benign, but some are atypical or malignant and can cause symptoms by compressing the brain, spinal cord, or cranial nerves.

### **Meningitis**

Meningitis is inflammation of the membranes around the brain and spinal cord, caused by infection or noninfectious inflammation and presenting

with headache, fever, neck stiffness, or altered mental status. infection but also by bacteria, fungi, parasites, medicines, or autoimmune disease. Symptoms may include fever, headache, neck stiffness, light sensitivity, or altered mental status and require urgent assessment.

### **Meningocele**

A congenital defect in which the membranes surrounding the spinal cord or brain protrude through an opening in the skull or spine, forming a fluid-filled sac. It may occur with other neural-tube defects and can cause neurologic problems; evaluation commonly includes imaging and specialist assessment.

### **Meningococcal Disease**

A bacterial infection caused by *Neisseria meningitidis* (serogroups A, B, C, W, Y), transmitted via respiratory droplets. Meningococcemia: sudden onset fever, petechial/purpuric rash, hypotension, and DIC. Meningococcal meningitis: fever, nuchal rigidity, headache, photophobia.

### **Meningococcal Infection**

Infection with *Neisseria meningitidis*, which may cause meningitis, bloodstream infection, or localized respiratory disease. Severe illness can progress rapidly.

### **Meningococcal Vaccine**

Conjugate vaccine (MenACWY) and serogroup B vaccine (MenB) given at 11-12 years with booster at 16 years. Protects against *Neisseria meningitidis*, causing meningitis and septicemia. MenACWY booster at 16 years covers the high-risk period for serogroup C and Y disease.

### **Meningoencephalitis**

Inflammation of both the meninges surrounding the brain and the brain tissue itself, usually caused by infection or autoimmune disease. Fever, headache, neck stiffness, confusion, seizures, or reduced consciousness requires urgent medical assessment.

### **Meniscal Injuries**

Tears or other damage to the knee menisci, which

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are crescent-shaped pieces of cartilage that help distribute load and stabilize the knee. Symptoms may include joint-line pain, swelling, clicking, or restricted motion. Diagnosis is based on examination and, when needed, imaging.

### **Meniscal Tear**

Tear of the C-shaped fibrocartilage (medial or lateral meniscus) that provides shock absorption and stability in the knee. Medial meniscus tears more common (attached to capsule). Mechanism: twisting injury with weight-bearing. Presents with joint line tenderness, pain with deep squatting, catching, locking, and giving way.

### **Menkes Disease**

An X-linked recessive disorder of copper metabolism caused by ATP7A mutations, resulting in impaired intestinal copper absorption and defective copper transport across the blood-brain barrier. Copper accumulates in intestinal and renal cells but is deficient in the liver and brain.

### **Menkes Kinky Hair Syndrome**

An X-linked disorder of copper transport caused by ATP7A dysfunction. It produces progressive neurodegeneration, seizures, developmental delay, hypopigmented or brittle kinky hair, connective-tissue abnormalities, and failure to thrive.

### **Menopausal Hormone Therapy**

Menopausal hormone therapy (MHT), formerly called hormone replacement therapy (HRT), is the use of estrogen with or without progestogen to alleviate moderate-to-severe menopausal vasomotor symptoms (hot flashes, night sweats), genitourinary syndrome of menopause (vaginal dryness, dyspareunia, urinary urgency), and prevent osteoporosis.

### **Menopause**

Menopause is the permanent end of menstrual periods after loss of ovarian follicular activity, accompanied by hormonal changes and possible vasomotor, genitourinary, sleep, and bone effects. woman's final period.

### **Menarche**

The first menstrual period, marking the onset of menstruation. Its timing varies with genetics, nutrition, health, and pubertal development; markedly early or delayed menarche may require assessment.

### **Menopause And Perimenopause**

Menopause is the permanent cessation of menstruation for 12 consecutive months, reflecting ovarian follicle depletion and estrogen decline, occurring at a median age of 51–52 years in North America.

### **Menorrhagia**

Heavy or prolonged menstrual bleeding that interferes with physical, social, emotional, or material quality of life. Causes include fibroids, adenomyosis, endometrial polyps, bleeding disorders, thyroid disease, and ovulatory dysfunction; it may cause iron-deficiency anemia.

### **Menstrual Cramps**

Cramping pain in the lower abdomen during or around menstruation, medically called dysmenorrhea. Pain may radiate to the back or thighs and may occur with nausea, diarrhea, headache, or fatigue. Severe, worsening, or newly developed pain requires evaluation for causes such as endometriosis or fibroids.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cramps, Menstrual Cramps Menstrual (Menstrual Cramps) Painful Periods

### **Menstrual Cycle**

The recurring hormonal and uterine changes that prepare the body for possible pregnancy. Cycle length and bleeding pattern vary among individuals and across life stages.

### **Menstruation**

The periodic shedding of the endometrial lining as part of the menstrual cycle when pregnancy does not occur. The timing, duration, and amount of bleeding vary with age, hormonal state, medicines, and health conditions.

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## Mental Health

Mental health encompasses emotional, psychologic, and social well-being, affecting how individuals think, feel, behave, and handle stress, relationships, and decision-making.

## Mental Status Examination

A structured assessment of the patient's current psychological functioning performed during the clinical interview. It evaluates appearance, behaviour, speech, mood, affect, thought process, thought content, perceptions, cognition, insight, and judgment.

## Mercury

Liquid metal combining with other metals to form amalgam. Concerns about toxicity, proper handling essential.

## Mercury Poisoning

Three forms: elemental (inhalation, neurological), inorganic (renal, GI), organic (methylmercury, neurological). Minamata disease from methylmercury. Treatment: chelation (dimercaprol, DMSA), remove exposure.

## Merkel Cell Carcinoma

An aggressive neuroendocrine skin cancer arising from Merkel cells. It presents as a rapidly growing, painless, red-violet nodule on sun-exposed skin of elderly patients. Approximately 80 percent are associated with Merkel cell polyomavirus. Risk factors include immunosuppression, UV exposure, and fair skin.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Merkel Cell Neuroendocrine Carcinoma Of The Skin

## Meropenem-Vaborbactam

A combination of the carbapenem meropenem with the cyclic boronate beta-lactamase inhibitor vaborbactam. Vaborbactam inhibits class A and class C beta-lactamases, including KPC carbapenemases, but does not inhibit class D or metallo-beta-lactamases. This combination has activity against many carbapenem-resistant Enterobacteriaceae.

## MERRF Syndrome

Myoclonic epilepsy with ragged-red fibres, a mitochondrial disorder usually caused by a pathogenic mitochondrial DNA variant. It features myoclonus, generalized epilepsy, ataxia, and skeletal-muscle mitochondrial abnormalities, with variable multisystem involvement.

## Mesenteric Artery Ischemia

Inadequate blood flow through the mesenteric arteries, usually caused by embolism, thrombosis, or severe low-flow states. Acute disease presents with severe abdominal pain out of proportion to examination and can progress to bowel infarction.

## Mesenteric Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to intestines. Acute: embolism, thrombosis. Chronic: atherosclerosis. CT angiography diagnosis.

## Mesentery

The fan-shaped double layer of peritoneum attaching the small intestine (jejunum and ileum) to the posterior abdominal wall, carrying the superior mesenteric artery, vein, lymphatics, and autonomic nerves between its layers. Root extends from duodenojejunal junction to ileocecal junction.

## Mesh

A synthetic or biological implant used to provide structural support in pelvic organ prolapse and stress urinary incontinence surgery. Types: polypropylene (most common, mid-urethral slings for SUI, vaginal mesh for prolapse), biological (porcine, bovine, or cadaveric dermis).

## Mesoderm

The middle germ layer in an embryo, which develops into muscles, bones, cartilage, blood vessels, and the kidneys.

## Messenger RNA

Single-stranded RNA molecule transcribed from DNA template, carrying genetic code from nucleus to ribosomes for protein synthesis. Contains 5' cap (methylguanosine), 5' UTR, coding sequence

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(codons), 3' UTR, and poly-A tail. Eukaryotic mRNA undergoes processing: splicing (intron removal, exon ligation), capping, polyadenylation.

### **Meta-Analysis**

A statistical method that combines quantitative results from multiple studies addressing a related question. Its validity depends on the quality and comparability of the studies.

### **Metabolic Acidosis**

A primary acid-base disorder characterized by decreased serum bicarbonate ( $<22$  mEq/L) and pH  $<7.35$ . Causes are classified by anion gap (AG). High AG: diabetic ketoacidosis, lactic acidosis, renal failure, starvation, toxins (methanol, ethylene glycol, salicylates).

### **Metabolic Alkalosis**

A primary increase in plasma bicarbonate or loss of hydrogen ions. Causes include vomiting, diuretic use, mineralocorticoid excess, and chloride depletion; respiratory compensation increases carbon dioxide but is limited by hypoxemia and acidosis.

### **Metabolic Rate**

The rate at which the body uses energy to maintain life and perform activity.

### **Metabolic Syndrome**

Cluster of conditions: abdominal obesity, hypertension, hyperglycemia, high triglycerides, low HDL. Increases cardiovascular disease and diabetes risk.

#### **Synonyms:**

Insulin Resistance Syndrome Syndrome X

### **Metabolic Tumor Volume**

Total volume of metabolically active tumor on PET. Prognostic in lymphoma.

### **Metabolism**

Metabolism comprises the chemical reactions that produce energy and synthesize or break down molecules in cells, including catabolism, anabolism, and regulated handling of nutrients and drugs. an-

abolism (synthesis, consumes energy). Central pathways: glycolysis, TCA cycle, oxidative phosphorylation, pentose phosphate pathway. Metabolic regulation ensures energy homeostasis.

### **Metacarpals**

Five long bones (I-V) forming the palm framework. Each has base, shaft, and head. The first is shortest and most mobile, articulating with the trapezium at a saddle joint for opposition. Second/third are firmly fixed; fourth/fifth more mobile. Bennett's fracture affects the first metacarpal base; boxer's fracture affects the fifth neck.

### **Metacarpophalangeal Joint**

A condyloid synovial joint between a metacarpal head and the base of a proximal phalanx. It permits flexion, extension, abduction, adduction, and limited circumduction.

### **Metagenomic Sequencing**

Sequencing of nucleic acid recovered directly from a clinical or environmental specimen to identify microbial genetic material without requiring growth in culture. It can detect unusual or polymicrobial infections but is vulnerable to contamination and requires clinical interpretation.

### **Metal Artifact**

Image degradation from metal implants. Reduced by metal artifact reduction sequences (MRI), iterative reconstruction (CT).

### **Metaphyseal Corner Fractures**

Bucket-handle or corner fractures at the metaphysis of long bones, characteristic of child abuse. Caused by twisting or pulling forces on extremities. Most common in the knee, ankle, and elbow. Seen on skeletal survey; may not be visible initially. Highly specific for non-accidental trauma in infants.

### **Metaphysis**

The region of a long bone between the epiphysis (end) and diaphysis (shaft), containing the epiphyseal growth plate (physis) in children—the zone of active cartilage growth (endochondral ossification).



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## Metaplasia

A reversible adaptive change in which one differentiated adult cell type is replaced by another, representing the body's attempt to better withstand a chronic stress or irritation. The process involves reprogramming of tissue stem cells to differentiate along a different lineage that is more resilient to the new environment. Persistent metaplasia may impair normal tissue function and, in some settings, increase susceptibility to dysplasia and malignant transformation. Examples include intestinal metaplasia in the stomach and squamous metaplasia in chronically irritated respiratory epithelium.

## Metastasectomy

Surgical removal of one or more metastases, which may be curative in selected oligometastatic disease, e.g., colorectal liver and lung metastases and sarcoma pulmonary metastases.

## Metastasis

Metastasis is spread of malignant cells from a primary tumor to noncontiguous tissues through lymphatic, blood, or body-cavity routes, forming secondary tumors. hematogenous, direct extension, transcoelomic. Common sites: lungs, liver, bone, brain. Distant metastasis indicates Stage IV disease.

## Metastasis Of Colorectal Cancer

Spread of colorectal malignancy to distant organs via lymphatic, hematogenous, or peritoneal routes, most commonly involving the liver, lungs, and peritoneum. The liver is the first site of metastasis due to portal venous drainage, and hepatic metastases may be resectable with curative intent.

## Metastasis-Free Survival

The time from treatment until the development of distant metastasis or death; an important endpoint in adjuvant therapy trials.

## Metastatic Adenocarcinoma

An adenocarcinoma that has spread from its primary site to distant organs, commonly the liver, lungs, bones, or brain. The prognosis and treatment depend on the primary tumor origin and the

extent of metastatic disease.

## Metastatic Calcification

The deposition of calcium salts in otherwise normal tissues due to systemic hypercalcemia, where elevated serum calcium levels exceed the tissue ability to maintain calcium homeostasis.

## Metastatic Cascade

Sequence of events in metastasis: local invasion, intravasation, circulation, extravasation, colonization. Many cells die during process.

## Metastatic Colon Cancer

Advanced colonic malignancy that has spread beyond the bowel to distant sites, most commonly the liver, lungs, and peritoneum, via lymphatic and hematogenous dissemination. Staging uses CT of chest, abdomen, and pelvis, and PET-CT may identify occult metastases.

## Metastatic Inguinal Lymphadenopathy

Enlargement of inguinal lymph nodes due to metastatic cancer cells, often from primary tumors of the lower extremities, pelvis, or anorectal region. It may indicate advanced disease requiring systemic therapy.

## Metastatic Lung Cancer

Lung cancer that has spread beyond the lungs to other organs, such as the brain, bones, liver, or adrenal glands. It represents advanced stage disease with limited treatment options.

## Metatarsals

Five long bones (I-V) forming the forefoot. Each has base, shaft, and head. First is shortest/thickest, bearing approximately one-third of forefoot load. Stress fractures commonly affect the second and third (march fractures). Morton's neuroma typically affects the nerve between 3rd/4th metatarsal heads.

## Metered-Dose Inhaler

A pressurized inhaler delivering a metered dose of medication. Requires proper technique for effective



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delivery. Spacer devices improve drug delivery and reduce oropharyngeal deposition. Most common delivery device for asthma and COPD maintenance.

### **Metformin In Prediabetes**

Metformin may reduce progression from prediabetes to type 2 diabetes, especially in people at high risk. Its use depends on age, body size, prior gestational diabetes, kidney function, other conditions, and patient preference; lifestyle intervention remains important.

### **Methacholine Challenge Test**

A bronchoprovocation test used when asthma is suspected but routine spirometry is nondiagnostic. Inhaled methacholine may cause bronchoconstriction, and spirometry is repeated after increasing doses. The result must be interpreted with symptoms, treatment, and other test findings because the test is not specific for asthma.

### **Methanol Poisoning**

Toxic ingestion or exposure to methanol, whose metabolites cause high-anion-gap metabolic acidosis and visual or neurologic injury. Treatment requires urgent toxicology consultation, antidotal fomepizole or selected ethanol therapy, correction of acidosis, and hemodialysis in severe cases.

### **Methemoglobinemia**

Methemoglobinemia occurs when hemoglobin iron is oxidized and cannot carry oxygen normally, causing cyanosis, headache, breathlessness, or severe tissue hypoxia.

### **Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus Aureus**

*Staphylococcus aureus* resistant to beta-lactam antibiotics through acquisition of the *mecA* gene encoding penicillin-binding protein 2a (PBP2a). MRSA is a major cause of healthcare-associated and community-associated infections. Treatment options include vancomycin, daptomycin, linezolid, and trimethoprim-sulfamethoxazole.

### **Methotrexate In Dermatology**

An immunomodulatory antimetabolite used in selected inflammatory and autoimmune skin diseases, including psoriasis, eczema, and some connective-tissue disorders. Treatment requires attention to liver disease, blood counts, infection risk, drug interactions, and strict pregnancy precautions.

### **Methylation**

Addition of methyl group to DNA (cytosine) or histones. DNA methylation at CpG islands typically silences genes. Hypomethylation associated with cancer.

### **Methylene Blue**

An oxidizing-reducing agent used primarily to treat clinically significant methemoglobinemia by facilitating conversion of methemoglobin to functional hemoglobin. It may be ineffective or hazardous in glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency and can interact with serotonergic drugs.

### **Methylmalonic Acid Level**

A blood or urine measurement used to assess functional vitamin B12 status. Elevated methylmalonic acid supports vitamin B12 deficiency, particularly when the serum vitamin B12 concentration is borderline. Renal impairment can also increase the level and should be considered during interpretation.

### **Metoclopramide**

A dopamine (D2) receptor antagonist and 5-HT3 antagonist used as a prokinetic antiemetic for gastroparesis, chemotherapy-induced and postoperative nausea, and GERD (facilitates gastric emptying).

### **Metronidazole**

A nitroimidazole antibiotic and antiprotozoal agent that is selectively toxic to anaerobic organisms and certain parasites. The drug is activated by reduction of its nitro group within anaerobic cells, generating toxic free radicals that damage DNA.

### **Metronidazole-Associated Encephalopathy**

A rare complication of prolonged or high-dose

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metronidazole therapy, causing cerebellar dysfunction (ataxia, dysarthria, nystagmus) and sometimes confusion or seizures. MRI may show T2-hyperintense lesions in the cerebellar dentate nuclei, corpus callosum splenium, and brainstem. Symptoms typically resolve with drug discontinuation.

### **MIBG Scan**

Nuclear medicine imaging using I-123 or In-111 MIBG. Detects pheochromocytoma, neuroblastoma.

### **Micafungin**

An echinocandin antifungal agent used in the treatment and prophylaxis of invasive candidiasis and esophageal candidiasis. Micafungin inhibits beta-(1,3)-D-glucan synthase, disrupting fungal cell wall synthesis and leading to osmotic instability and cell death.

### **Michaelis-Menten Kinetics**

The mathematical model describing the rate of enzyme-catalyzed reactions as a function of substrate concentration.

### **Microalbuminuria**

Excretion of 30 to 300 mg of albumin daily undetectable by standard dipstick. Earliest marker of diabetic nephropathy and cardiovascular risk predictor. Detected by urine albumin-to-creatinine ratio on spot specimen. Normal less than 30 mg/g creatinine. Signals early glomerular damage in diabetes warranting RAAS blockade initiation.

### **Microangiopathic Hemolysis**

Red-cell fragmentation and intravascular hemolysis caused by passage through abnormal small vessels, producing schistocytes, elevated LDH, and reduced haptoglobin.

### **Microarray**

Technology measuring expression of thousands of genes simultaneously or detecting copy number variations. Gene expression microarrays: compare expression patterns. SNP arrays: detect genetic variations. Comparative genomic hybridization (CGH): detect deletions/duplications.

### **Microbiome**

The collection of microorganisms (bacteria, archaea, fungi, viruses—the microbiota) and their genetic material inhabiting a host's body surfaces, particularly the gastrointestinal tract.

### **Microcephaly**

Microcephaly is head size substantially smaller than expected for age and sex, reflecting genetic, developmental, infectious, toxic, or acquired brain causes.

### **Micrognathia**

Micrognathia is an unusually small lower jaw that may affect feeding, teeth, facial development, or airway breathing.

### **Micrograms**

A unit of mass equal to one millionth of a gram, written as  $\mu\text{g}$ .

### **Micrometastasis**

A small deposit of cancer cells that has spread from the primary tumor but is not detectable clinically or on standard imaging, e.g., isolated tumor cells in a sentinel lymph node; relevant to staging and prognosis.

### **Micromolar**

A concentration unit equal to one millionth of a mole per liter, written as  $\mu\text{mol/L}$ .

### **Micronutrients**

Vitamins and minerals required in small amounts for enzymatic, hormonal, structural, hematologic, neurologic, and immune functions. They include fat-soluble vitamins (A, D, E, and K), water-soluble vitamins, and essential minerals.

### **Microphthalmia**

A congenitally small eye, ranging from mild (reduced axial length) to severe with structural anomalies. Associated with coloboma, congenital cataract, and genetic syndromes; can cause vision loss and requires optical correction, amblyopia therapy, and sometimes socket rehabilitation.

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## MicroRNA

Small non-coding RNA regulating gene expression. Post-transcriptional regulation.

## Microsatellite Instability

A molecular pattern caused by deficient DNA mismatch-repair function, resulting in length changes in short repetitive DNA sequences. MSI-high tumors may have increased mutation burden and can be eligible for particular immunotherapies.

## Microscope

Magnifies small structures. Types: light, electron, fluorescent. Essential for histology, hematology, microbiology.

## Microscopic Colitis

Umbrella term encompassing both collagenous colitis and lymphocytic colitis which share the clinical presentation of chronic watery non-bloody diarrhea and the pathophysiological feature of colonic mucosal inflammation. Endoscopic appearance is typically normal necessitating random biopsies for diagnosis.

### Synonyms:

Colitis, Microscopic

## Microscopic Examination

The pathologic evaluation of tissue or cells under the light or electron microscope, complementing the gross examination to form the complete morphologic diagnosis. Routine light microscopy uses hematoxylin and eosin sections to assess architecture, cellular morphology, mitotic activity, and relation to margins.

## Microscopic Polyangiitis

A necrotizing vasculitis affecting small blood vessels (capillaries, venules, arterioles) with few or no immune deposits (pauci-immune). Part of the ANCA-associated vasculitis group. Strongly associated with MPO-ANCA (p-ANCA, 80%).

## Microwave Ablation

A procedure that uses microwave energy to heat

and destroy selected tissue, usually under imaging guidance.

## Micturition

The process of urination, coordinated by the pontine micturition center, parasympathetic (pelvic nerve, S2-S4) contraction of the detrusor muscle, and relaxation of the internal (involuntary) and external (voluntary, pudendal nerve) urethral sphincters.

## Mid-Systolic Click

A sharp, high-pitched sound occurring in mid-to-late systole, associated with mitral valve prolapse. The click represents sudden tensing of the elongated chordae tendineae as the prolapsing leaflet billows into the left atrium. It may be followed by a late systolic murmur of mitral regurgitation.

## Mid-Upper-Arm Circumference

The circumference of the upper arm measured at the midpoint between the acromion and olecranon processes. It is a practical anthropometric measure of muscle and fat stores, particularly useful when body weight or height cannot be measured reliably.

## Midaxillary Line

An imaginary vertical line on the side of the body passing through the apex of the axilla (armpit).

## Midbrain

Most superior brainstem segment connecting pons to diencephalon. Contains cerebral peduncles (corticospinal/corticobulbar tracts), substantia nigra (dopaminergic neurons degenerated in Parkinson's), red nucleus (rubrospinal tract for coordination), and periaqueductal gray (pain modulation).

## Midclavicular Line

An imaginary vertical line on the front of the body passing through the midpoint of the clavicle (collarbone).

## Middle Ear

An air-filled space between the eardrum and inner ear that contains the malleus, incus, and stapes.

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These ossicles transmit sound vibrations to the inner ear, and the auditory tube helps equalize middle-ear pressure.

### **Middle East Respiratory Syndrome**

A severe respiratory infection caused by Middle East respiratory syndrome coronavirus, usually acquired through close contact with infected camels or people. It can cause pneumonia, respiratory failure, and renal or multiorgan complications.

#### **Synonyms:**

MERS (Middle East Respiratory Syndrome)

### **Middle Lobe Syndrome**

Chronic or recurrent atelectasis and infection of the right middle lobe due to bronchial obstruction. The long, narrow right middle lobe bronchus is susceptible to compression by lymph nodes, tumors, or mucous plugging. It may be caused by bronchiectasis, malignancy, or granulomatous disease. Treatment depends on the underlying cause.

### **Midtrimester**

The middle third of pregnancy, from 14 to 28 weeks gestation. The midtrimester is when many women feel their best: nausea and fatigue of the first trimester resolve, and the physical discomforts of the third trimester have not yet developed.

### **Migraine With Aura**

A primary headache disorder characterized by recurrent attacks of fully reversible visual, sensory, or speech symptoms that develop gradually over at least five minutes and last no more than sixty minutes, followed by headache with the characteristics of migraine.

### **Migraine Without Aura**

A primary headache disorder characterized by recurrent attacks of moderate to severe, pulsating, unilateral headache lasting four to seventy-two hours, associated with nausea, vomiting, photophobia, and phonophobia.

### **Migrating Motor Complex**

Cyclical patterns of intense gastrointestinal motil-

ity occurring during fasting (interdigestive period), sweeping residual food, bacteria, and debris from the stomach through the small intestine to the colon.

### **Mild Cognitive Impairment**

A transitional cognitive state between normal aging and dementia, characterized by subjective cognitive complaints confirmed by objective cognitive impairment that is not severe enough to significantly interfere with daily activities.

### **Milia**

Milia are small, firm, white or yellow keratin-filled cysts just beneath the epidermis, commonly on the face; they are usually harmless and may resolve or be removed if persistent.

### **Miliaria Crystallina**

A benign, asymptomatic eruption of small, clear, superficial vesicles caused by obstruction of eccrine sweat ducts in the stratum corneum, occurring in hot, humid environments or during high fevers. The vesicles resemble dewdrops on the skin and rupture easily, leaving fine scales.

### **Miliary TB**

Hematogenous dissemination of *M. tuberculosis* causing innumerable 1–3 mm granulomas throughout lungs and other organs. CXR shows “millet seed” pattern. More common in immunocompromised patients.

### **Miliary Tuberculosis**

Disseminated tuberculosis caused by hematogenous spread of *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, producing numerous tiny granulomatous lesions in the lungs and potentially multiple organs. Symptoms may include prolonged fever, weight loss, night sweats, cough, and organ-specific manifestations.

### **Millimolar**

A concentration unit equal to one thousandth of a mole per liter, written as mmol/L.

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### **Milrinone**

A phosphodiesterase-3 inhibitor with positive inotropic and vasodilatory (inodilator) actions, increasing cAMP in cardiac and vascular smooth muscle.

### **Milroy Disease**

An inherited primary lymphedema caused most often by pathogenic variants affecting VEGFR3 signaling. It typically presents with chronic swelling of the lower limbs from birth or early infancy and may be associated with papillomatosis, hydrocele, or recurrent skin infection.

### **Mindful Eating**

Paying attention to hunger cues, eating slowly, savoring food. May reduce overeating, improve digestion.

### **Mineralocorticoid Receptor**

An intracellular steroid receptor activated primarily by aldosterone in the kidney, colon, sweat glands, and other tissues. Its activation increases sodium reabsorption and potassium and hydrogen secretion and contributes to blood-pressure regulation and tissue remodeling.

### **Mineralocorticoid Receptor Antagonist**

A drug that blocks aldosterone receptors, promoting natriuresis while limiting potassium loss and adverse cardiac remodeling. Spironolactone and eplerenone improve outcomes in selected heart-failure patients; hyperkalemia and renal dysfunction require monitoring.

### **Mini-Mental State Examination**

A brief structured cognitive screening instrument assessing orientation, registration, attention, calculation, recall, language, and visuospatial ability. Scores are affected by education, language, sensory impairment, culture, and delirium and do not establish a dementia diagnosis alone.

### **Minimal Change Disease**

A cause of nephrotic syndrome, especially in children, in which the glomeruli appear nearly normal by light microscopy but podocyte foot processes are

effaced on electron microscopy. It causes marked protein loss in the urine and edema.

### **Minimal Residual Disease**

The small number of malignant cells that remain after treatment and are below detection by conventional clinical examination or routine microscopy. Sensitive flow-cytometric, molecular, or imaging methods may detect MRD and refine relapse-risk assessment.

### **Minimum Alveolar Concentration**

The alveolar concentration of an inhaled anesthetic that prevents movement in half of people exposed to a standardized painful surgical stimulus. It is used to compare the potency of volatile anesthetics.

### **Minimum Bactericidal Concentration**

The lowest concentration of an antimicrobial that kills a defined proportion of the original bacterial inoculum, commonly demonstrated by subculture without growth. MBC is distinct from MIC and is not routinely required for every infection.

### **Minimum Effect Concentration**

The lowest concentration of a drug in the blood or at its site of action that produces a defined measurable effect.

### **Minimum Inhibitory Concentration**

The lowest concentration of an antimicrobial that prevents visible growth of a microorganism under standardized laboratory conditions. It helps characterize susceptibility, but results must be interpreted with the organism, specimen, assay, and clinical context.

### **Minimum Lethal Concentration**

The lowest concentration of a substance associated with death in a defined test population or experimental setting.

### **Minute Ventilation**

The total volume of air breathed in one minute (tidal volume x respiratory rate). Normal is 6–8



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L/min. Elevated in increased metabolic demand, pain, anxiety, and sepsis. Reduced in neuromuscular disease and sedation.

### **Miosis**

Constriction of the pupil, produced mainly by parasympathetic activity through the oculomotor nerve and sphincter pupillae muscle. It may be physiologic or caused by medicines, toxins, neurologic disease, or ocular conditions.

### **MIRD Schema**

Medical Internal Radiation Dose. Method for calculating radiation absorbed doses.

### **Mirizzi Syndrome**

Condition where a gallstone impacted in the cystic duct or Hartmann pouch extrinsic compression of the common hepatic duct causing obstructive jaundice. Classified into four types based on the degree of erosion and fistula formation. Type one is extrinsic compression without fistula.

### **Mirror Therapy**

Mirror reflection of unaffected limb movement creates visual illusion of affected limb moving. Reduces phantom limb pain, improves stroke recovery.

### **Mismatch Repair Deficiency**

Loss of DNA mismatch-repair function that produces microsatellite instability and a high tumor mutational burden. Seen in Lynch syndrome and some sporadic colorectal, endometrial, and other cancers, and associated with responsiveness to immune checkpoint inhibitors.

### **Misoprostol (Cytotec)**

A synthetic prostaglandin analogue used for selected gynecologic and obstetric indications, including cervical ripening, labor induction, and medical management of some pregnancies. It can cause uterine contractions, bleeding, gastrointestinal effects, or uterine tachysystole; use depends on the clinical setting and gestational age.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cytotec

### **Missense Variant**

A single-nucleotide substitution that changes one amino acid in a protein. Its clinical effect ranges from benign to pathogenic and must be assessed using molecular, functional, population, and clinical evidence.

### **Mitochondria**

Double-membrane organelles known as the "powerhouse of the cell," generating ATP through oxidative phosphorylation. Outer membrane is permeable; inner membrane is highly folded (cristae) and contains the electron transport chain and ATP synthase.

### **Mitochondrial Diabetes**

Diabetes caused by mutations in mitochondrial DNA particularly the m.3243A>G mutation in the MT-TL1 gene. Maternally inherited. Often associated with sensorineural hearing loss termed maternally inherited diabetes and deafness. Patients are typically lean with impaired insulin secretion. Diagnosis requires genetic testing.

### **Mitochondrial Disease**

A group of genetic disorders caused by impaired mitochondrial energy production. Symptoms vary and may affect the brain, muscles, nerves, heart, eyes, or multiple organs; onset and severity can differ widely even within one family.

### **Mitochondrial Inheritance**

Inheritance of mitochondrial DNA, which is transmitted predominantly through the egg and therefore usually from the mother. Examples include Leber hereditary optic neuropathy and MELAS. Heteroplasmy means that mutant and normal mitochondrial DNA coexist in a cell.

### **Mitosis**

Cell division that produces two genetically similar daughter cells with the same chromosome number as the parent cell.

### **Mitotic Figure**

A cell undergoing nuclear division that can be identified microscopically. Mitotic count contributes



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to assessment of proliferative activity and tumor grade, although counting method and area must be standardized.

### **MitraClip**

A transcatheter device that creates a double orifice in the mitral valve by clipping the anterior and posterior leaflets together, reducing mitral regurgitation. It is indicated for patients with significant (3+ or 4+) mitral regurgitation who are at high risk for surgical mitral valve repair.

### **Mitral Regurgitation**

Incomplete closure of the mitral valve allowing blood to flow backward from the left ventricle to the left atrium during systole. Causes include mitral valve prolapse, papillary muscle dysfunction, rheumatic disease, and ischemic heart disease. Murmur: pansystolic (holosystolic) blowing murmur at the apex radiating to the axilla.

### **Mitral Stenosis**

Narrowing of the mitral valve opening, obstructing left atrial to left ventricular blood flow. Most commonly caused by rheumatic heart disease. Symptoms include dyspnea, fatigue, and atrial fibrillation. Murmur: low-pitched, rumbling mid-diastolic murmur at the apex with opening snap.

### **Mitral Stenosis Murmur**

Low-pitched, rumbling mid-diastolic murmur at the apex, best heard with the bell of the stethoscope in the left lateral decubitus position. Accompanied by an opening snap (early diastolic high-pitched click) and loud S1 in pliable valves. Severe MS may show a diastolic murmur without a preceding S2 gap.

### **Mitral Valve**

Left atrioventricular (bicuspid) valve with anterior and posterior cusps supported by chordae tendineae and papillary muscles. Anterior cusp is larger and proximate to the aortic valve. Mitral valve prolapse is the most common valvular abnormality. Mitral stenosis (most commonly rheumatic) and regurgitation are significant.

### **Mitral Valve Prolapse**

A valvular heart disease where the mitral valve leaflets prolapse into the left atrium during systole. Most patients are asymptomatic; some develop palpitations, atypical chest pain, or dyspnea. Diagnosis by echocardiography. Complications include mitral regurgitation, infective endocarditis, and arrhythmias.

#### **Synonyms:**

Barlow's Syndrome Barlow Syndrome (Mitral Valve Prolapse) Click-Murmur Syndrome Prolapse, Mitral Valve

### **Mitral-Valve Repair**

A surgical or transcatheter procedure to restore mitral valve competence without replacement, typically for regurgitation from prolapse, chordal rupture, or ischemic dysfunction. Repair preserves native valve tissue, maintains left ventricular function, and avoids lifelong anticoagulation required by mechanical prostheses.

### **Mixed Connective Tissue Disease**

An overlap syndrome with features of systemic lupus erythematosus, systemic sclerosis, and polymyositis/dermatomyositis. Highly associated with anti-U1 RNP antibodies. Presents with Raynaud phenomenon (nearly universal), puffy hands, arthritis, myositis, esophageal dysmotility, and serositis. Renal disease is less common than in SLE.

#### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis MCTD (Mixed Connective Tissue Disease)

### **Mixed Hearing Loss**

A combination of both conductive and sensorineural hearing loss occurring in the same ear, resulting in a hearing deficit that involves impaired sound transmission through the outer or middle ear in addition to cochlear or neural dysfunction.

### **Mixed Urinary Incontinence**

Involuntary leakage of urine, significantly affecting psychological, social, and physical well-being. See urinary incontinence.

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## MMR Vaccine

A live attenuated vaccine against measles, mumps, and rubella. It is given according to the immunization schedule and is generally avoided during pregnancy and in people with certain severe immune deficiencies.

## Mobile Genetic Elements

Genetic elements that can move within and between genomes. These include plasmids, transposons, and integrons. Mobile genetic elements can carry antibiotic resistance genes and virulence factors. They facilitate horizontal gene transfer and contribute to the rapid evolution of bacteria.

## Mobile Health (MHealth)

Use of mobile devices for health. Examples: health apps, text message reminders, wearable devices.

### Synonyms:

mHealth

## Modafinil

A wakefulness-promoting agent (mechanism not fully understood, likely dopaminergic) used for narcolepsy, obstructive sleep apnea residual sleepiness, and shift work sleep disorder; used off-label for fatigue and ADHD. Less abuse potential and fewer sympathomimetic effects than amphetamines.

## Modified Biophysical Profile (Modified BPP)

A simplified antepartum test combining the non-stress test (NST) with the amniotic fluid index (AFI). The NST assesses acute fetal status (heart rate reactivity over 20-40 minutes) and the AFI assesses chronic uteroplacental function (oligohydramnios suggests chronic hypoxia or placental insufficiency).

### Synonyms:

Modified BPP

## Mohs Surgery

A micrographically controlled technique in which skin cancer is excised in thin layers and examined margin-by-margin, achieving high cure rates for basal cell and squamous cell carcinoma while sparing

normal tissue.

## Molar Pregnancy

A type of gestational trophoblastic disease characterized by abnormal proliferation of trophoblastic tissue. See Hydatidiform Mole.

## Mole

Nevus: a benign proliferation of melanocytes, the most common skin lesion; also used for other nevi (moles are melanocytic nevi). Types: junctional (flat, brown—childhood), compound (slightly raised), intradermal (dome-shaped, flesh/pigmented).

## Molecular Pathology

The investigation of disease using nucleic-acid, genomic, epigenomic, or molecular protein alterations in cells and tissues. It may establish diagnosis, estimate prognosis, identify inherited risk, or select targeted therapy.

## Molecular Testing

Analysis of DNA, RNA, or other molecular features to identify variants, fusions, expression patterns, or infectious agents for diagnosis, prognosis, or treatment selection.

## Molecular Weight

Mass of molecule. Important for dosing, toxicity calculations.

## Molluscum Contagiosum

A viral skin infection caused by a poxvirus, presenting as firm, dome-shaped, umbilicated papules with central dimpling, 2 to 5 mm in diameter. It is transmitted by direct skin contact, autoinoculation, and sexual contact in adults. Immunocompetent hosts clear lesions spontaneously within 6 to 12 months.

## Molybdenum-99

Parent isotope of Tc-99m, half-life 66 hours. Produced in nuclear reactors. Generator systems provide Tc-99m for 1 week.

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### **Mondor's Disease**

Superficial thrombophlebitis of the anterior chest wall veins, typically the lateral thoracic, thoracoepigastric, or superior epigastric veins. Presents as a tender, cord-like subcutaneous structure with skin retraction. Usually self-limited; associated with breast surgery, trauma, or hypercoagulable states.

### **Monitored Anesthesia Care**

A distinct service where an anesthesia professional provides premedication, administration of analgesics and/or sedatives, continuous monitoring of the patient's cardiorespiratory status, and intervention for any emergent or unavoidable complications that may arise during a diagnostic or therapeutic procedure.

### **Monitoring Test**

Test to track disease progression or treatment response.

### **Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitors**

Antidepressants that inhibit monoamine oxidase, the enzyme responsible for breaking down serotonin, norepinephrine, and dopamine. MAOIs include phenelzine, tranylcypromine, isocarboxazid, and selegiline (transdermal). They are effective for atypical depression and treatment-resistant depression.

### **Monoclonal Antibody**

An antibody produced by a single cloned B-cell line, specific for one epitope, generated by hybridoma technology or recombinant methods (name suffix -mab).

### **Monocyte**

A circulating leukocyte (2-8 percent) that differentiates into macrophages and dendritic cells in tissues. Monocytes phagocytose pathogens, present antigens, and secrete cytokines (TNF, IL-1, IL-6); participate in innate immunity, inflammation, and tissue repair. Subsets differ in function (classical, nonclassical, intermediate).

### **Mononucleosis**

Mononucleosis is an infectious syndrome commonly caused by Epstein-Barr virus, with fever, sore throat, swollen lymph nodes, and fatigue.

#### **Synonyms:**

Kissing Disease Mono

### **Monosodium Urate**

The crystalline salt that precipitates in tissues when serum uric acid levels exceed the saturation point, forming needle-shaped, negatively birefringent crystals under polarized light microscopy. It is the pathological hallmark of gout, depositing in joints, soft tissues, and kidneys.

### **Monosomy**

Presence of one copy of a chromosome instead of the usual two. Complete autosomal monosomies are generally not compatible with life; monosomy X and some mosaic or structural forms can survive and have variable features.

### **Monospot (EBV Heterophile Antibody)**

A rapid blood test that detects heterophile antibodies associated with infectious mononucleosis. It may be negative early in illness or in young children and does not directly detect Epstein-Barr virus; specific antibody testing may be needed.

#### **Synonyms:**

EBV Heterophile Antibody

### **Monounsaturated Fat**

A fat whose fatty acids contain one carbon-carbon double bond. It occurs in foods such as olive oil, avocados, nuts, and some seeds.

### **Montevideo Units**

A quantitative measure of uterine contraction intensity, calculated by summing the peak contraction pressures (in mm Hg) minus the resting tone for each contraction in a 10-minute window. Adequate labor:  $\geq 200$  MVU (spontaneous) or  $\geq 250$  MVU (augmented). Measured with an intrauterine pressure catheter (IUPC).

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### Montgomery Tubercles

Small, raised sebaceous glands visible on the areola of the breast during pregnancy and lactation. They appear as small bumps surrounding the nipple and secrete an oily substance that lubricates the nipple and areola, protecting against infection. Their prominence increases during pregnancy under hormonal influence.

### Montreal Cognitive Assessment

A brief cognitive screening instrument with greater emphasis on executive function, visuospatial ability, attention, memory, language, and orientation than many shorter screens. Interpretation requires consideration of education, language, sensory deficits, and acute illness.

### Mood Stabilizers

Medications used to treat mood episodes in bipolar disorder and prevent recurrence. The primary mood stabilizers are lithium, valproate, carbamazepine, and lamotrigine. Each has a different mechanism and side effect profile. Lithium is the only agent with demonstrated anti-suicide properties.

### Morbid Obesity

Severe obesity defined clinically as BMI  $\geq 40$  kg/m<sup>2</sup> or BMI  $\geq 35$  kg/m<sup>2</sup> with obesity-related comorbidities (type 2 diabetes, hypertension, obstructive sleep apnoea, non-alcoholic fatty liver disease, osteoarthritis, cardiovascular disease).

### Morbidity

Illness, disease, or disability in an individual or population. Morbidity measures may describe prevalence, incidence, complications, or functional effects.

### Morgagni Hernia

A congenital diaphragmatic hernia occurring through the anterior retrosternal foramen of Morgagni, resulting from incomplete fusion of parts of the diaphragm. Abdominal contents may move into the chest and cause respiratory or gastrointestinal symptoms.

### Morning Sickness

Nausea and vomiting of pregnancy (NVP): nausea (and sometimes vomiting) commonly in the first trimester (6-12 weeks), typically resolving by 14-16 weeks; multifactorial (hCG, estrogen, progesterone, odor sensitivity).

### Moro Reflex

A primitive reflex present from birth to 3-6 months, elicited by suddenly startling the infant (loud noise, head drop). The infant extends both arms outward with fingers spread, then draws arms inward as if embracing. Absence at birth suggests central nervous system injury or brachial plexus palsy.

### Mortality

Death rate in population. Elderly mortality: higher rates, common causes: cardiovascular disease, cancer, dementia, respiratory disease, fall-related injuries. Life expectancy varies by sex, race, socioeconomic status.

### Mortality Rate

Deaths from disease in population. Crude: total deaths / total population. Specific: disease-specific deaths / population at risk.

### Morton Neuroma

A perineural fibrosis of the plantar digital nerve, most commonly between the third and fourth metatarsal heads. It presents as burning pain, numbness, and a feeling of walking on a pebble. It is not a true neuroma but a mechanical entrapment neuropathy.

#### Synonyms:

Interdigital Neuroma Neuroma, Plantar Plantar Neuroma

### Mosaicism

A medical term referring to mosaicism. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Motion Analysis

Assessment of movement patterns. 3D gait analysis, video analysis. Identifies abnormalities, guides

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treatment.

### **Motion Artifact**

Image distortion or blurring caused by movement of the patient, organs, or equipment during image acquisition.

### **Motion Correction**

Correction for patient motion during acquisition. Respiratory gating, navigation.

### **Motion Sickness**

Nausea, dizziness, sweating, or vomiting caused by sensory mismatch during travel or other motion. It can occur in cars, boats, aircraft, amusement rides, or virtual-reality environments and usually improves when motion stops. Severe or persistent symptoms require assessment for other causes.

### **Motivational Interviewing**

A client-centered, directive counseling method for enhancing intrinsic motivation to change by exploring and resolving ambivalence. Developed by Miller and Rollnick, it uses the spirit of partnership, acceptance, compassion, and evocation. Core skills include open-ended questions, affirmations, reflections, and summaries.

### **Motor Cortex**

The frontal-lobe regions that plan and initiate voluntary movement. The primary motor cortex lies in the precentral gyrus and controls the opposite side of the body in an orderly somatotopic map.

### **Motor Learning**

A relatively lasting change in the ability to perform a motor skill resulting from practice, experience, feedback, and adaptation. Rehabilitation uses task-specific repetition and meaningful practice to promote motor learning.

### **Motor Unit**

A single alpha motor neuron and all the skeletal muscle fibers it innervates. The number of muscle fibers per motor unit determines precision of con-

trol: small motor units (few fibers, e.g., extraocular and hand muscles) provide fine movement; large motor units (hundreds to thousands of fibers, e.g., gastrocnemius) provide gross power.

### **Mouth**

The oral cavity that serves as the entry point of the digestive tract, used for eating, breathing, and speaking.

### **Mouth Ulcers**

Open sores affecting the oral mucosa, commonly caused by aphthous ulcers, trauma, infection, irritation, or systemic inflammatory disease. Most resolve within two weeks; persistent, recurrent, unusually large, or indurated ulcers require evaluation.

### **Mouthwash**

A liquid rinsed around the mouth and then expelled to freshen breath, deliver an active ingredient, or reduce selected oral microorganisms.

### **Movement Disorder**

A neurologic condition causing excessive, reduced, or otherwise abnormal movement. Hyperkinetic disorders include tremor, dystonia, chorea, myoclonus, tics, and dyskinesia; hypokinetic disorders include bradykinesia and parkinsonism.

### **Moyamoya Disease**

A progressive occlusive arteriopathy of the terminal internal carotid arteries and their proximal branches, with development of fragile collateral vessels at the brain base. It can cause transient ischemic attacks, strokes, seizures, headaches, or cognitive impairment.

### **Mpox**

Mpox is a zoonotic infection caused by monkeypox virus, producing fever, lymph-node enlargement, and a characteristic rash or lesions that can occur on skin, mouth, or genital areas. nodes, and a distinctive rash that may include deep-seated vesicles or pustules.



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## **Mpox (Monkeypox)**

A zoonotic viral disease caused by the monkeypox virus, an orthopoxvirus in the same genus as smallpox (variola) and vaccinia. The virus has two clades: clade I (formerly Congo Basin, Central African) with higher virulence and mortality (up to 10 percent), and clade II (formerly West African) with lower mortality (less than 1 percent).

### **Synonyms:**

monkeypox

## **MR Angiography**

Vascular imaging using MRI without ionizing radiation. Time-of-flight (TOF) or contrast-enhanced (CE-MRA). Used for cerebral aneurysms, renal artery stenosis, peripheral arterial disease.

## **MR Enterography**

MRI of the small bowel after oral contrast administration. Superior soft tissue contrast for evaluating Crohn disease activity, fistulas, and abscesses without ionizing radiation. Demonstrates mural thickening, edema, enhancement patterns, and extraintestinal complications. Diffusion-weighted imaging helps assess disease activity.

## **MR Neurography**

Magnetic resonance imaging optimized to show peripheral nerves and abnormalities such as swelling, compression, or injury.

## **MRCP (Magnetic Resonance Cholangiopancreatography)**

Non-invasive MRI of the biliary and pancreatic ducts using heavily T2-weighted sequences that highlight static fluid. Used for: choledocholithiasis (CBD stones), biliary strictures, primary sclerosing cholangitis, pancreatic duct anatomy, and congenital biliary anomalies.

### **Synonyms:**

Magnetic Resonance Cholangiopancreatography

## **MRI**

MRI examines mri; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. images of body tissues.

## **MRI (Magnetic Resonance Imaging)**

Imaging using strong magnetic fields and radiofrequency pulses to generate detailed cross-sectional images. No ionizing radiation. Superior soft-tissue contrast compared to CT.

### **Synonyms:**

Magnetic Resonance Imaging

## **MRI Brain**

Excellent for brain pathology: tumors, stroke, demyelination, infection, degeneration. Sequences: T1, T2, FLAIR, DWI, SWI, contrast-enhanced. DWI detects acute ischemia within minutes.

## **MRI Contrast**

A contrast agent administered during magnetic resonance imaging to improve visibility of selected tissues or abnormalities.

## **MRI Joint**

Evaluation of musculoskeletal structures: cartilage, ligaments, tendons, menisci, labrum. Knee: ACL, meniscus tears. Shoulder: rotator cuff, labrum. Hip: labral tears, FAI.

## **MRI Sequences**

T1-weighted: anatomy, fat bright. T2-weighted: pathology, fluid bright. FLAIR: suppresses CSF, lesions bright. DWI: restricted diffusion bright (acute stroke, abscess). STIR: fat suppression, fluid bright.

## **MRNA Vaccine**

A vaccine delivering messenger RNA encoding a pathogen antigen that host cells translate into protein, triggering an immune response. Approved for COVID-19 (Pfizer-BioNTech, Moderna) and RSV; under study for influenza, cancer, and other infections.

## **MRSA**

Methicillin-resistant *Staphylococcus aureus*, resistant to beta-lactam antibiotics through acquisition of the *mecA* gene encoding PBP2a. MRSA is a major cause of healthcare-associated and community-associated infections. Treatment options include



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vancomycin, daptomycin, and linezolid.

### **MRSA Decolonization**

Measures intended to reduce MRSA carriage on the skin or in the nose. Protocols may include topical agents and antiseptic bathing, but the indication, regimen, and duration depend on the person's risk, infection history, setting, and local guidance.

### **MRV (Magnetic Resonance Venography)**

MRI technique to visualize veins, using time-of-flight (TOF) or contrast-enhanced sequences. Indications: cerebral venous sinus thrombosis, dural sinus stenosis, abdominal/pelvic venous thrombosis, portal vein thrombosis, and renal vein thrombosis. Differentiates acute vs. chronic thrombus.

#### **Synonyms:**

Magnetic Resonance Venography

### **MTOR**

Mammalian target of rapamycin. Controls cell growth, proliferation. Inhibited by rapamycin.

### **Mucocele**

Mucus extravasation cyst of minor salivary gland. Lower lip most common. Treatment: excision.

### **Mucolytic Therapy**

Medications that reduce mucus viscosity and elasticity, facilitating clearance. N-acetylcysteine (NAC) breaks disulfide bonds in mucus glycoproteins. Dornase alfa (Pulmozyme) cleaves extracellular DNA in CF sputum. Hypertonic saline aerosol draws water into the airway surface liquid.

### **Mucormycosis**

Mucormycosis is an invasive infection by Mucorales fungi, typically affecting immunocompromised people and causing rapidly destructive sinus, orbital, pulmonary, cutaneous, or disseminated disease. *Mucor*, and *Rhizomucor* species. The infection primarily affects immunocompromised patients, particularly those with uncontrolled diabetes mellitus and hematologic malignancies. The fungi invade blood vessels causing thrombosis and tissue infarction.

### **Mucosal Irritation**

Chemical injury to mucous membranes. Eyes, nose, throat, GI tract. Treatment: irrigation, supportive care.

### **Mucositis**

Inflammation and ulceration of the oral or gastrointestinal mucosa caused by chemotherapy or radiation, causing pain, dysphagia, and poor intake and predisposing to local infection.

### **Mucus Plugging**

Accumulation of thick, tenacious mucus within airways causing obstruction. It is common in asthma, CF, bronchiectasis, and chronic bronchitis. It impairs gas exchange, promotes infection, and causes atelectasis. Treatment includes airway clearance techniques, mucolytics, and bronchodilators.

### **Muenke Syndrome**

A craniosynostosis syndrome caused by a pathogenic FGFR3 variant. Premature fusion of one or more skull sutures may produce an abnormal head shape and can be accompanied by developmental, hearing, limb, or neurological findings.

### **MUGA Scan (Multigated Acquisition Scan)**

ECG-gated radionuclide imaging using technetium-labeled red blood cells to measure ventricular ejection fraction and wall motion. It can be used when reproducible ejection-fraction measurement is needed, although echocardiography and cardiac MRI are also important alternatives.

#### **Synonyms:**

Multigated Acquisition Scan

### **Multicystic Dysplastic Kidney**

A congenital renal anomaly where one or both kidneys are replaced by multiple non-communicating cysts of varying sizes, with no functioning renal parenchyma. The most common cause of an abdominal mass in a newborn (unilateral). The ureter is typically atretic. The contralateral kidney may have VUR (20%) or UPJ obstruction (10%).

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### **Multidisciplinary Disaster Victim Identification**

The coordinated process of identifying victims of mass-fatality incidents (natural disasters, transport crashes, terrorist attacks) using multiple disciplines: fingerprinting, dental records, DNA profiling, forensic anthropology/radiology, and personal effects, with ante-mortem data collection and comparison.

### **Multidisciplinary Team**

Rehabilitation team includes: physiatrist, physical therapist, occupational therapist, speech-language pathologist, psychologist, social worker, case manager, nursing, recreation therapist.

### **Multidrug-Resistant TB**

TB resistant to at least isoniazid and rifampin. Requires second-line drugs for 18–24 months. Worse outcomes and higher mortality than drug-susceptible TB.

### **Multifocal Atrial Tachycardia**

An atrial tachyarrhythmia with at least three distinct P-wave morphologies, irregular rhythm, and a rate above 100 beats per minute. It is strongly associated with severe pulmonary disease, hypoxia, and metabolic stress.

### **Multimodal Analgesia**

Use of analgesic techniques with different mechanisms to improve pain control while reducing reliance on any single drug, especially opioids. Components may include acetaminophen, nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, regional anesthesia, local anesthetics, and selected adjuvants.

### **Multimorbidity**

The coexistence of two or more chronic health conditions in the same person, without requiring one to be considered the primary disease. It complicates treatment, increases polypharmacy risk, and requires coordinated patient-centered care.

### **Multiparametric MRI Of The Prostate**

MRI protocol combining T2-weighted, diffusion-weighted, and dynamic contrast-enhanced sequences

to detect and characterize clinically significant prostate cancer. Findings are commonly reported using the PI-RADS system.

### **Multiple Bacterial Abscesses**

Numerous circumscribed collections of pus within an organ or tissue, caused by hematogenous seeding or direct extension of bacterial infection. They appear as multiple, low-attenuation lesions on imaging, often with peripheral enhancement. Common sites include the liver, brain, and kidneys.

### **Multiple Biliary Hamartomas**

Benign, congenital malformations of the intrahepatic bile ducts appearing as multiple, small, well-defined cystic lesions scattered throughout the liver parenchyma on imaging. They are typically asymptomatic and discovered incidentally. They must be distinguished from metastatic disease and Caroli disease.

### **Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 1**

An autosomal dominant tumor syndrome caused by MEN1 gene mutation (menin).

### **Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2**

An inherited tumor syndrome caused by pathogenic variants in the RET gene. Type 2A is associated with medullary thyroid carcinoma, pheochromocytoma, and hyperparathyroidism. Type 2B is associated with medullary thyroid carcinoma, pheochromocytoma, mucosal neuromas, and a marfanoid habitus.

### **Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2B**

An inherited RET-associated syndrome characterized by medullary thyroid carcinoma, pheochromocytoma, mucosal neuromas, and a marfanoid habitus. The thyroid-cancer risk is high and requires early specialist genetic and surgical assessment.

### **Multiple Myeloma**

A cancer of plasma cells that usually develops in the bone marrow and often produces a monoclonal immunoglobulin. It can cause bone lesions, anemia, kidney dysfunction, high calcium, infection, or other

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organ damage.

**Synonyms:**

Cancer, Multiple Myeloma Kahlers Disease (Multiple Myeloma)

**Multiple Pregnancy**

Gestation with more than one fetus: twins (most common), triplets, higher order. Types: dizygotic (two eggs, two placentas—fraternal, more common, familial and increased with IVF) vs. monozygotic (one egg split—identical, sharing determined by timing: dichorionic-diamniotic, monochorionic-diamniotic, monoamniotic, conjoined).

**Multiple Sclerosis**

A chronic autoimmune demyelinating disease of the central nervous system, most commonly presenting in young adults. Characterized by relapsing-remitting episodes of neurological dysfunction (optic neuritis, transverse myelitis, brainstem syndromes). Diagnosis: McDonald criteria with MRI dissemination in space and time.

**Synonyms:**

Sclerosis, Multiple

**Multiple System Atrophy**

A progressive, fatal neurodegenerative disorder characterized by varying combinations of autonomic failure, cerebellar ataxia, parkinsonism, and pyramidal signs.

**Synonyms:**

Shy-Drager Syndrome

**Multiplex PCR (BioFire, FilmArray)**

A molecular test that detects genetic material from multiple organisms in one clinical sample. Different panels are designed for respiratory, gastrointestinal, bloodstream, or other specimens. Results require interpretation with the symptoms and may detect colonization or nonviable organisms as well as active infection.

**Synonyms:**

BioFire, FilmArray

**Mummification**

Postmortem alteration occurring in hot, dry, arid, ventilated environments where rapid desiccation of tissues occurs before putrefaction can proceed, resulting in dry, leathery, dark brown skin clinging to underlying skeleton.

**Mumps**

Mumps is a contagious paramyxovirus infection causing painful salivary-gland swelling and fever, with possible meningitis, orchitis, pancreatitis, or hearing complications. include orchitis (rarely causing infertility), meningitis, pancreatitis, and sensorineural hearing loss. Prevention by MMR vaccination. Outbreaks occur in unvaccinated populations. Diagnosis by serology or RT-PCR from saliva.

**Synonyms:**

Parotitis (Mumps)

**Mumps Virus**

A paramyxovirus that causes mumps, a contagious respiratory illness. The virus is transmitted by respiratory droplets. Symptoms include fever, headache, and parotitis. Complications include orchitis, oophoritis, meningitis, and deafness. Diagnosis involves serology and PCR.

**Mural Thrombus**

A mural thrombus is a blood clot that forms on the wall of a heart chamber or large blood vessel, typically in areas of damaged endothelium, stasis, or turbulent flow.

**Murmur**

An extra or unusual heart sound caused by turbulent blood flow. Murmurs are described by timing, location, intensity, quality, radiation, and response to position; their significance ranges from innocent flow sounds to valve or structural disease.

**Murmur Classification**

Heart murmurs are classified by timing, grade, shape, location, radiation, and pitch. Timing: systolic (between S1 and S2), diastolic (between S2 and S1), or continuous. Grade: I (barely audible) to

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VI (heard without stethoscope). Shape: crescendo, decrescendo, or plateau.

## **Muscle**

A specialized contractile tissue responsible for movement, posture, and heat production.

## **Muscle Atrophy**

Loss or wasting of muscle tissue caused by disuse, nerve injury, inflammation, malnutrition, or systemic disease. It may lead to weakness and reduced function; treatment focuses on the cause, nutrition, and appropriately supervised rehabilitation.

## **Muscle Contraction**

The shortening or tension generation of muscle produced by the interaction of actin and myosin myofilaments. In skeletal and cardiac muscle, contraction follows excitation-contraction coupling: calcium binds troponin, tropomyosin moves aside, and myosin cross-bridges cycle against actin (sliding filament mechanism) using ATP.

## **Muscle Pain (Myalgia)**

Myalgia—muscle pain—is a common symptom arising from skeletal muscle injury, inflammation, overuse, infection, or systemic disease.

### **Synonyms:**

Myalgia

## **Muscle Tissue**

A highly specialized tissue capable of contracting to produce body movement, posture, and heat.

## **Muscle Weakness**

Reduced ability to generate force with one or more muscles. Causes include nerve or muscle disease, pain, inactivity, medicines, metabolic disorders, and aging.

## **Muscular Dystrophy**

A group of inherited disorders characterized by progressive skeletal-muscle weakness and degeneration. The pattern, age of onset, and complications vary by genetic type; some forms also affect the heart,

respiratory muscles, or other organs.

### **Synonyms:**

MD

## **Musculocutaneous Nerve**

From lateral cord (C5-C7), piercing coracobrachialis, running between biceps and brachialis to supply these muscles and lateral forearm skin (lateral antebrachial cutaneous nerve). Sole motor supply to the anterior arm compartment. Injury causes weakness of elbow flexion/forearm supination with lateral forearm sensation loss.

## **Musculoskeletal Pain**

Pain arising from muscles, bones, joints, ligaments, tendons, or related soft tissues. Common causes include injury, overuse, arthritis, and inflammation; persistent pain, weakness, swelling, or neurologic symptoms should be assessed.

## **Music Therapy**

Use of music for therapeutic purposes. Pain reduction, emotional expression, cognitive stimulation.

## **Mutagen**

A chemical, physical agent, or biological factor capable of causing a genetic mutation. Mutagenicity does not by itself prove that an agent causes cancer.

## **Mutation**

A heritable or acquired alteration in the DNA sequence. Variants may be single-nucleotide substitutions, insertions, deletions, copy-number changes, or larger rearrangements and may be benign, pathogenic, or of uncertain significance.

## **Mutation Rate**

Frequency of new mutations per generation or per base pair per replication. Varies by gene, genomic region, organism. High mutation rate in repetitive sequences.

## **Myalgic Encephalomyelitis**

A complex illness characterized by substantial reduction in activity, post-exertional malaise, and un-

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refreshing sleep, often with cognitive or autonomic symptoms.

### **Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome**

A complex illness characterized by substantial reduction in activity, post-exertional malaise, unrefreshing sleep, and cognitive or autonomic symptoms. Management is individualized and focuses on pacing, symptom relief, and treatment of coexisting conditions.

### **Myasthenia Gravis**

An autoimmune disorder of neuromuscular transmission causing fluctuating, fatigable muscle weakness. It may affect the eyes, facial and swallowing muscles, limbs, or breathing muscles; antibodies and other tests help classify the disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

MG

### **Myasthenic (Lambert-Eaton) Syndrome**

An autoimmune presynaptic neuromuscular-junction disorder caused by antibodies against voltage-gated calcium channels, producing proximal weakness and autonomic symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lambert-Eaton

### **Mycobacterium Abscessus**

A rapidly growing nontuberculous mycobacterium that can cause pulmonary, skin, and soft-tissue infections and is often difficult to treat because of multidrug resistance.

### **Mycobacterium Avium Complex**

A group of nontuberculous mycobacteria that can cause chronic pulmonary disease or disseminated infection, particularly in people with impaired immunity. Treatment depends on the species, site, severity, susceptibility, and patient factors.

### **Mycobacterium Leprae**

An acid-fast bacillus that causes leprosy (Hansen's disease), a chronic infection affecting the skin and

peripheral nerves. The organism is transmitted through respiratory droplets, though the exact mechanism is not fully understood. The incubation period is long (2-5 years).

### **Mycobacterium Marinum**

A nontuberculous mycobacterium associated with fish tanks and aquatic exposure that can cause chronic skin and soft-tissue infection.

### **Mycobacterium Tuberculosis**

An acid-fast bacillus that causes tuberculosis, a chronic respiratory infection. The organism is transmitted by respiratory droplets and primarily affects the lungs but can disseminate to other organs. Latent TB infection is asymptomatic and non-transmissible. Active TB presents with cough, haemoptysis, fever, and weight loss.

### **Mycology**

The branch of microbiology that studies fungi, including yeasts, moulds, and mushrooms. Medical mycology focuses on fungal pathogens that cause disease in humans. Fungal infections (mycoses) are classified as superficial, cutaneous, subcutaneous, or systemic.

### **Mycoplasma Genitalium**

A sexually transmitted bacterium that can cause urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, and, less commonly, proctitis. Many infections are asymptomatic. Diagnosis is usually by a nucleic acid amplification test, and macrolide resistance is common, so treatment should follow current susceptibility-informed guidance.

### **Mycoplasma Pneumonia**

Atypical pneumonia most common in ages 5–35. Dry cough, low-grade fever, headache. Patchy infiltrates on CXR disproportionate to symptoms (“walking pneumonia”).

### **Mycoplasma Pneumoniae-Associated Mucositis**

Inflammatory lesions of the oral, ocular, or genital mucosa occurring as an extrapulmonary manifes-



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tation of *Mycoplasma pneumoniae* infection, often presenting with target-like skin lesions.

### **Mycosis Fungoides**

The most common cutaneous T-cell lymphoma, presenting with progressive patches, plaques, and tumors on the skin with an indolent course. Staging and therapy depend on skin involvement and extracutaneous spread.

#### **Synonyms:**

MF

### **Mydriasis**

Dilation of the pupil, produced mainly by sympathetic activity through the dilator pupillae muscle or by reduced parasympathetic activity. Causes include darkness, medicines, toxins, neurologic disease, and ocular injury.

### **Myelin**

Myelin is an insulating sheath around nerve fibers that speeds electrical conduction; it is produced by oligodendrocytes in the CNS and Schwann cells in the PNS.

### **Myelin Sheath**

The lipid-rich insulating layer around axons formed by Schwann cells (peripheral nervous system) and oligodendrocytes (central nervous system), which wrap the axon in concentric membrane layers.

### **Myelodysplastic Syndrome**

MDS: a group of clonal stem cell disorders characterized by ineffective hematopoiesis, cytopenias, and risk of transformation to acute myeloid leukemia (AML). Features: anemia (most common), neutropenia, thrombocytopenia; dysplasia (abnormal morphology) in marrow and blood; cytogenetic abnormalities (del5q, trisomy 8, del7q).

### **Myelofibrosis**

Myelofibrosis is a myeloproliferative neoplasm in which abnormal marrow signaling causes fibrosis, disordered blood production, anemia, enlarged spleen, and variable constitutional symptoms. hematopoiesis, and JAK2, CALR, or MPL muta-

tions. Presents with anemia, massive splenomegaly, constitutional symptoms (fever, night sweats, weight loss), and leukoerythroblastic blood smear.

#### **Synonyms:**

Idiopathic Myelofibrosis

### **Myelography**

Contrast injected into subarachnoid space for spinal imaging. Used when MRI contraindicated. CT myelography more common now.

### **Myeloma**

Multiple myeloma: plasma cell malignancy. Features: bone pain, anemia, renal failure, hypercalcemia.

### **Myeloma Cast Nephropathy**

Light chain cast formation in tubules causing AKI in multiple myeloma. Friable waxy casts with giant cells. Bence Jones proteinuria. Treat myeloma and consider plasmapheresis to reduce light chain burden.

### **Myelomeningocele**

Myelomeningocele is an open neural-tube defect in which spinal cord and meninges protrude through a vertebral opening, causing variable paralysis, sensory loss, bladder dysfunction, and hydrocephalus. through a vertebral defect into a sac on the back. Presents with a visible, fluid-filled sac at birth. Associated with hydrocephalus, Arnold-Chiari malformation, and lower extremity paralysis.

### **Myelopathy**

A general term for any neurological deficit resulting from spinal cord pathology, encompassing a wide range of causes and clinical presentations.

### **Myelosuppression**

Reduced bone marrow production of red cells, white cells, and platelets, causing anemia, neutropenia, and thrombocytopenia; a common dose-limiting toxicity of chemotherapy and radiation that increases infection and bleeding risk.



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## Myiasis

Infestation of living tissue by larvae (maggots) of various fly species, which feed on host tissue and can cause pain, secondary infection, and tissue destruction. It may be cutaneous, involving the skin and subcutaneous tissue, or affect other body sites including the nose, ears, and wounds.

## Myocardial Infarction

Irreversible death of heart-muscle tissue caused by prolonged inadequate blood flow. See Heart Attack.

## Myocardial Perfusion Imaging

Nuclear cardiology technique using radiotracers (Tc-99m sestamibi, Tl-201) to assess blood flow to the myocardium. Performed at rest and during stress (exercise or pharmacological) to detect reversible ischemia (stress defect with rest redistribution) or fixed defects (scar from prior MI).

## Myocardial Viability

PET assessment of hibernating myocardium. FDG uptake indicates viable myocardium.

## Myocarditis

Myocarditis is inflammation of heart muscle, often infectious or immune-mediated, that can cause chest pain, arrhythmias, heart failure, or sudden cardiac dysfunction. (coxsackievirus, adenovirus, SARS-CoV-2). Presents with chest pain, dyspnea, arrhythmias, and elevated troponin. Diagnosis: ECG, echocardiography, cardiac MRI with Lake Louise criteria, and endomyocardial biopsy.

## Myocarditis Diagnosis

Cardiac MRI (Lake Louise criteria) shows myocardial edema (T2-weighted imaging), late gadolinium enhancement (typically epicardial/mid-wall in non-ischemic distribution), and increased myocardial T1/T2 mapping values.

## Myocarditis Treatment

No specific antiviral therapy for most cases. Treatment is supportive: heart failure therapy (diuretics, ACE inhibitors, beta-blockers) for reduced EF, arrhythmia management, and avoidance of exercise

during acute phase (risk of sudden death). Immunosuppression may be considered in autoimmune myocarditis or cardiac sarcoidosis.

## Myotonia Congenita

An inherited skeletal-muscle channelopathy causing delayed relaxation after voluntary contraction. Stiffness often improves with repeated movement and may be accompanied by muscle hypertrophy; onset and severity vary between genetic forms.

## Myotonic Dystrophy

The most common adult-onset muscular dystrophy, an autosomal dominant multisystem disorder caused by CTG trinucleotide repeat expansions in the DMPK gene (type 1, DM1) or CCTG tetranucleotide repeat expansions in the CNBP gene (type 2, DM2) on chromosome 19q13.3. DM1 is more common and more severe than DM2.

## Myringotomy With Tympanostomy Tube

Incision of the tympanic membrane with placement of a ventilation tube to equalize middle-ear pressure and permit drainage. It is used selectively for persistent middle-ear effusion, recurrent acute otitis media, or associated hearing and developmental problems.

## Myxedema Coma

Severe decompensated hypothyroidism characterized by altered mental status, hypothermia, bradycardia, hypoventilation, hyponatremia, and hypoglycemia. Most commonly occurs in elderly patients with long-standing untreated hypothyroidism precipitated by infection, surgery, or sedative medications. Mortality rates exceed fifty percent.

### Synonyms:

Coma Myxedema (Myxedema Coma)

## Myxoma

A usually benign primary cardiac tumour composed of myxoid tissue, most often arising in the left atrium from the interatrial septum. It may cause positional obstruction of the mitral valve, constitutional symptoms, or systemic embolism; echocardiography is the usual initial diagnostic test.

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### **MéNéTrier's Disease**

A rare acquired gastropathy characterized by massive hypertrophy of the gastric mucosal folds, particularly in the body and fundus, with foveolar hyperplasia, cystic dilation of gastric glands, and glandular atrophy. It presents with epigastric pain, nausea, vomiting, weight loss, and protein-losing enteropathy causing hypoalbuminemia.

### **Macrocytic Anemia**

Anemia in which red blood cells are larger than normal, commonly because of vitamin B12 or folate deficiency.

### **Macular Edema**

Swelling of the macula caused by fluid leaking from retinal blood vessels.

### **Maintenance Of Wakefulness Test**

A sleep test that measures how long a person can remain awake in a quiet setting during the day.

### **Mastoid Bone**

The portion of the temporal bone located behind the ear.

### **Megaloblastic Anemia**

Anemia caused by impaired DNA synthesis, usually related to vitamin B12 or folate deficiency, with abnormally large red blood cells.

### **Microaneurysm**

A small bulge in the wall of a blood vessel.

### **Microvascular Disease**

Disease affecting small blood vessels, which may reduce blood flow to organs or tissues.

### **Mitral Valve Stenosis**

Narrowing of the mitral valve that restricts blood flow from the left atrium to the left ventricle.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stenosis, Mitral Valve

### **Morton's Neuroma**

Thickening of tissue around a nerve in the forefoot, causing burning pain or numbness between the toes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mortons Neuroma (Morton's Neuroma)

### **Multiple Sleep Latency Test**

A daytime sleep study that measures how quickly a person falls asleep during scheduled naps.

### **Myasthenia**

Abnormal muscle weakness that worsens with use.

### **Myocardial Rupture**

A tear in the heart wall or other heart structure, usually a severe complication of myocardial infarction.

### **MéNièRe's Disease**

An inner-ear disorder causing episodes of vertigo, fluctuating hearing loss, tinnitus, and ear pressure.

### **Maxillary Sinusitis**

Inflammation or infection of the air-filled sinus cavities behind the cheekbones.

### **Microcytic Anemia**

Anemia in which red blood cells are smaller than normal, commonly because of iron deficiency or a thalassemia.

### **Mitochondrial Myopathy**

Muscle weakness or dysfunction caused by abnormalities of mitochondria, the energy-producing structures of cells.

### **Mitral Valve Insufficiency**

Leakage of the mitral valve that allows blood to flow back into the left atrium.

### **Mobius Syndrome**

A rare congenital disorder causing facial weakness or paralysis and limited outward eye movement.

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### Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia

An inherited disorder causing tumors or overactivity in two or more endocrine glands.

### Myxedema

Severe hypothyroidism causing accumulation of mucin in tissues, with swelling, slowed body functions, and other symptoms.

### Male Breast Cancer

Cancer that develops in breast tissue in a man.

#### Synonyms:

Breast Cancer, Male

### Malignant Peripheral Nerve Sheath Tumor

A cancer arising from cells associated with peripheral nerves.

### Mammary Duct Ectasia

Widening and inflammation of a milk duct beneath the nipple.

### Marginal Zone Lymphoma

A slow-growing non-Hodgkin lymphoma that begins in immune cells in the marginal zone of lymphoid tissue.

#### Synonyms:

MZL

### MCAD Deficiency

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly break down certain medium-chain fats for energy.

### Metastatic Castration-Resistant Prostate Cancer

Prostate cancer that has spread and continues to grow despite treatments that lower testosterone.

### Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome

Compression of the celiac artery by a ligament near the diaphragm, sometimes causing abdominal pain.

### Medication Overuse Headaches

Frequent headaches caused or worsened by regular overuse of headache medicines.

#### Synonyms:

Rebound Headache

### Macrocephaly

An unusually large head size for a person's age and sex, which may be familial or associated with hydrocephalus, brain growth, or other disorders.

### Macroductyly

Abnormally large fingers or toes, usually caused by overgrowth of bone and soft tissue.

### Macropsia

A visual disturbance in which objects appear larger than they actually are.

### Madura Foot (Mycetoma)

A chronic localized infection of the skin and deeper tissues of the foot, caused by fungi or certain bacteria and characterized by swelling, draining sinuses, and granules.

#### Synonyms:

Mycetoma

### Metal Fume Fever

A short-lived influenza-like illness caused by inhalation of fumes from heated metals, especially zinc; symptoms include fever, chills, headache, muscle aches, and cough.

### Methaemoglobinaemia

A condition in which haemoglobin is oxidized to methaemoglobin and cannot release oxygen effectively, causing tissue hypoxia and sometimes cyanosis.

### Microtia

A congenital abnormality in which the external ear is unusually small or incompletely formed; it may occur with narrowing or absence of the ear canal.

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### **Molar Pregnancy (Hydatidiform Mole)**

An abnormal pregnancy in which placental tissue proliferates excessively and the embryo is absent or abnormal; it is a form of gestational trophoblastic disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hydatidiform Mole

### **Mesenteric Lymphadenitis**

Inflammation of lymph nodes in the membrane that attaches the intestines to the abdominal wall.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphadenitis, Mesenteric

### **Metastatic Breast Cancer**

Breast cancer that has spread from the breast to distant parts of the body.

### **Manometry**

Measurement of pressure within a body organ or passage, such as the esophagus or rectum.

### **Micropenis**

An unusually small penis caused by inadequate androgen effect or other developmental conditions, defined clinically by a stretched penile length more than 2.5 standard deviations below the mean for age and population. Evaluation may identify endocrine or genetic causes.

### **Microcalcification**

A very small calcium deposit in tissue, sometimes an early sign of breast cancer.

### **Myelogram**

An imaging study of the spinal canal performed after contrast material is introduced around the spinal cord.

### **Myomectomy**

Surgical removal of uterine fibroids while preserving the uterus.

### **Mallet**

A surgical hammer used with instruments such as

osteotomes to cut or shape bone.

### **Mayo Scissors**

Heavy surgical scissors used to cut fascia, muscle, sutures, and other relatively tough material.

### **Metzenbaum Scissors**

Fine, lightweight surgical scissors used to dissect and cut delicate soft tissue.

### **Mosquito Clamp**

A small hemostatic clamp used to compress small blood vessels.

### **Mallet Finger**

An injury to the extensor tendon at the distal finger joint, causing inability to actively straighten the fingertip. It may result from a forced flexion injury and sometimes includes an avulsion fracture.

### **Mediastinal Mass**

An abnormal growth or collection of tissue in the mediastinum, the central compartment of the chest. Causes include tumors, enlarged lymph nodes, cysts, and vascular abnormalities.

### **Morphea**

A localized sclerosing skin disorder that produces areas of thickened, hardened, or discolored skin and differs from systemic sclerosis by usually lacking internal-organ involvement.

### **Myofascial Pain Syndrome**

A regional pain disorder involving sensitive trigger points in muscle and fascia, with pain that may be referred to other areas and often worsens with pressure or movement.

### **Microangiopathic Hemolytic Anemia**

An anemia caused by mechanical fragmentation of red blood cells as they pass through damaged or narrowed small blood vessels, producing schistocytes and often elevated hemolysis markers.

### **Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome In**

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## Children

A serious delayed inflammatory illness occurring in some children after infection with SARS-CoV-2, involving fever and two or more organ systems and potentially causing shock or cardiac dysfunction.

## Missed Miscarriage

A nonviable intrauterine pregnancy that has not been expelled and may produce few or no symptoms of miscarriage. Diagnosis requires appropriate ultrasound or other clinical evaluation before management is selected.

### Synonyms:

Missed abortion; delayed miscarriage.

## M Phase

The mitotic phase of the cell cycle, during which duplicated chromosomes are separated and the cell divides into two daughter cells; it includes mitosis and cytokinesis.

## Machine Learning

A computational approach in which algorithms learn patterns from data and use them to make predictions or decisions without being explicitly programmed for every rule; medical uses include image analysis and risk prediction.

## Macroautophagy

The major form of autophagy, in which portions of cytoplasm, damaged organelles, or proteins are enclosed in double-membrane autophagosomes and delivered to lysosomes for degradation and recycling.

## Macrococcus

macrococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Macrococcus Caseolyticus

macrococcus caseolyticus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Macroglobulin

A plasma globulin with a high molecular mass, generally formed by the association of several immunoglobulin or other protein subunits; immunoglobulin M is a principal example.

## Macrolide

A class of antibiotics containing a large macrocyclic lactone ring that generally inhibit bacterial protein synthesis by binding the 50S ribosomal subunit; examples include erythromycin, azithromycin, and clarithromycin.

## Macrolide Antibiotic

An antibiotic of the macrolide class that binds the bacterial 50S ribosomal subunit and usually inhibits protein synthesis; activity and resistance vary by organism and drug.

## Macronucleus

The larger, transcriptionally active nucleus of a ciliate protozoan that controls routine cellular functions; it differs from the smaller micronucleus involved in genetic reproduction.

## Macrophage Activation

The process by which macrophages respond to signals such as microbial products or cytokines and increase phagocytosis, antigen presentation, and production of inflammatory or tissue-repair mediators.

## Macrophage Count

The measured number or proportion of macrophages in a tissue, fluid, or laboratory sample; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, and clinical context.

## Macroscopic Hematuria

Visible blood in the urine, also called gross hematuria; it may arise from the kidneys, ureters, bladder, prostate, or urethra and requires evaluation for

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causes such as infection, stones, trauma, or malignancy.

### **Macrostomia**

An abnormally wide mouth or oral opening, usually a congenital facial cleft caused by incomplete fusion of the embryonic facial processes.

### **Macular Drusen**

Yellowish deposits of extracellular material between the retinal pigment epithelium and Bruch membrane in the macula; larger or numerous drusen are associated with age-related macular degeneration.

### **Maculopapular Lesion**

A skin lesion combining flat areas of altered color (macules) with small raised solid lesions (papules); it can occur in infections, drug eruptions, inflammatory diseases, and other conditions.

### **Madurella**

madurella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Madurella Mycetomatis**

madurella mycetomatis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Maf Protein**

maf protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Mafosfamide**

An activated oxazaphosphorine alkylating compound related to ifosfamide and cyclophosphamide, studied for antineoplastic activity and capable of cross-linking DNA.

### **Magnesium Chloride**

A magnesium salt used in some oral supplements and medical preparations to provide magnesium or, in concentrated solutions, to help correct magnesium deficiency; dosing depends on the elemental magnesium content.

### **Magnesium Oxide**

An inorganic magnesium compound used in some supplements and antacids; it can also have a laxative effect, and excessive use may cause hypermagnesemia, especially with kidney impairment.

### **Magnesium Sulfate**

A magnesium salt used intravenously or intramuscularly to treat selected magnesium deficiencies and conditions such as eclampsia, and used orally as an osmotic laxative; it is also known as Epsom salt in its hydrated form.

### **Magnet**

An object that produces a magnetic field and attracts ferromagnetic materials; magnets are used in devices such as magnetic-resonance imaging systems, while unproven magnet therapies should not replace effective treatment.

### **Magnetic Field**

The region around a magnet or electric current in which magnetic forces act; in medicine, controlled magnetic fields are used in MRI and some other technologies.

### **Magnetosomes**

Intracellular, membrane-bound structures in certain bacteria that contain magnetic minerals, commonly magnetite or greigite, and help the bacteria orient along magnetic-field lines.

### **Magnusiomyces Capitatus**

An opportunistic yeast formerly known as *Geotrichum capitatum* or *Saprochaete capitata*; it can cause invasive infections, especially in people with severe immunosuppression or hematologic malignancy.



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## Maintenance

Ongoing care or treatment intended to preserve health, prevent relapse or deterioration, or sustain a therapeutic result; maintenance therapy is continued after initial control of a condition.

## Majeed Syndrome

A clinical condition or finding involving majeed syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Majewski Syndrome

A clinical condition or finding involving majewski syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Malabsorption Syndrome

A clinical condition or finding involving malabsorption syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Malaria Vaccine

A vaccine intended to reduce malaria caused by *Plasmodium* parasites, especially *P. falciparum*; the RTS,S/AS01 and R21/Matrix-M vaccines are used in recommended childhood immunization programs in some endemic settings, alongside other preventive measures.

## Malassezia

malassezia is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

## Malassezia Furfur

malassezia furfur is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

## Malassezia Pachydermatis

malassezia pachydermatis is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evi-

dence of invasive or superficial infection.

## Malathion

An organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase; topical formulations have also been used to treat head lice, but exposure or ingestion can cause cholinergic toxicity.

## Male

Describing a sex associated with reproductive anatomy that produces or is organized around small gametes (sperm); chromosomes, hormones, anatomy, and gender identity do not always fit a simple binary pattern.

## Male Condom

A thin sheath placed over the penis before sexual contact to reduce the risk of pregnancy and transmission of many sexually transmitted infections by acting as a physical barrier.

## Male Phenotype

The observable reproductive anatomy, secondary sex characteristics, and other traits associated with male sex development, produced by interacting genetic, hormonal, and developmental factors and showing natural variation.

## Malignant Ameloblastoma

A biological or biochemical term involving malignant ameloblastoma. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Malignant Bone Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving malignant bone neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Malignant Glioma

An aggressive primary tumor arising from glial or glial-like cells of the central nervous system; high-grade examples include anaplastic astrocytoma and glioblastoma.

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### **Malignant Mastocytosis**

An older term for an aggressive systemic mast-cell neoplasm characterized by abnormal mast-cell proliferation and organ infiltration; modern classification distinguishes aggressive systemic mastocytosis and mast-cell leukemia.

### **Malignant Myoepithelioma**

A malignant tumor showing myoepithelial differentiation, arising most often in a salivary gland or other glandular tissue and capable of local invasion and metastasis.

### **Malignant Thymoma**

An older term for an invasive thymic epithelial tumor; modern usage distinguishes invasive thymoma from thymic carcinoma, which is a separate, more aggressive thymic malignancy.

### **Mallory Body**

An eosinophilic cytoplasmic inclusion in a hepatocyte, composed largely of damaged intermediate filaments and associated proteins; it is classically seen in alcohol-associated liver disease but is not specific to it.

### **Malondialdehyde**

A reactive aldehyde produced during oxidation of polyunsaturated lipids; it is commonly measured as an indirect marker of lipid peroxidation and oxidative stress.

### **Maltodextrin**

A mixture of short glucose polymers produced by partial hydrolysis of starch, used as a rapidly digestible carbohydrate and as a thickener, filler, or carrier in foods and medicines.

### **Maltose**

A reducing disaccharide composed of two glucose molecules joined by an alpha-1,4 glycosidic bond, produced during starch digestion and hydrolyzed by maltase.

### **Mammaglobin A**

A secretory protein expressed predominantly in mammary tissue and used as an immunohistochemical marker that can help identify breast origin in some metastatic carcinomas.

### **Mammals**

Warm-blooded vertebrate animals that have hair or fur, three middle-ear bones, and mammary glands that produce milk; humans are mammals.

### **Mammaplasty**

mammaplasty is used in relation to mammaplasty during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Mammary Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving mammary disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Mammary Epithelium**

The epithelial lining of the mammary ducts and secretory alveoli; these cells help produce, secrete, and transport milk and can give rise to many breast carcinomas.

### **Mammillary Body**

One of a pair of rounded nuclei on the underside of the hypothalamus that participate in memory circuits connecting the hippocampus with the thalamus; injury can contribute to memory impairment.

### **Managed Care**

A system of organizing and financing health care through provider networks, utilization review, care coordination, and negotiated payment arrangements intended to control costs and maintain quality.

### **Mandatory Reporting**

A legal or regulatory duty to report specified findings or circumstances—such as suspected child or elder abuse, certain communicable diseases, or some injuries—to designated authorities; requirements vary by jurisdiction.

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### **Mandibular Condyle**

The rounded superior end of each mandibular ramus that articulates with the temporal bone at the temporomandibular joint and permits jaw movement.

### **Mandibular Prosthesis**

An artificial implant or device used to replace, reconstruct, stabilize, or restore part of the mandible after trauma, tumor removal, congenital deformity, or other loss of jaw structure.

### **Mandibulofacial Dysostosis**

A congenital craniofacial disorder, classically Treacher Collins syndrome, involving underdevelopment of the mandible and cheekbones with variable abnormalities of the ears, eyes, and palate.

### **Manic**

Relating to mania, a pathological episode of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy or activity and associated changes in thought, speech, sleep, or judgment.

### **Manic Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving manic disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Manic Mood**

An abnormally elevated, expansive, or persistently irritable mood accompanied by increased energy or activity, reduced need for sleep, rapid speech, racing thoughts, inflated self-esteem, or risky behavior; it is characteristic of a manic episode.

### **Manipulation Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to manipulation procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Mannan**

A polysaccharide composed primarily of mannose units, found in the cell walls or capsules of many fungi and in some plants; fungal mannans can be

recognized by the immune system and used in laboratory testing.

### **Mannheimia**

A biomedical term referring to mannheimia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mannheimia Haemolytica**

A biomedical term referring to mannheimia haemolytica; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mannomustine**

Mannomustine is an older nitrogen-mustard alkylating agent investigated or used historically in lymphoma and other malignancies; it cross-links DNA and can cause myelosuppression and other cytotoxic effects.

### **Mannose**

A six-carbon monosaccharide related to glucose that forms part of glycoproteins and glycolipids and is important in protein glycosylation and cell recognition.

### **Mannosidosis**

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient alpha-mannosidase activity, leading to accumulation of mannose-rich oligosaccharides and variable intellectual, skeletal, immune, hearing, and neurologic abnormalities.

### **Mansonella Perstans**

A biomedical term referring to mansonella perstans; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mansonella Streptocerca**

mansonella streptocerca is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

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pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mansonelliasis**

Infection with filarial nematodes of the genus *Mansonella*, transmitted by biting midges or blackflies; many infections are asymptomatic, but some cause itching, skin lesions, fever, or eosinophilia.

### **Mantle Field**

A historical radiation-treatment field encompassing lymph-node regions in the neck, mediastinum, and upper chest, formerly used for Hodgkin lymphoma; modern treatment generally uses more limited involved-site fields.

### **Manufactured Form**

A drug, chemical, nutrient, or other product prepared by an industrial or laboratory process into a defined formulation, such as a tablet, capsule, solution, or injectable preparation.

### **MAO Inhibitor**

A drug that inhibits monoamine oxidase, the enzyme that metabolizes monoamine neurotransmitters; some are used for depression or Parkinson disease and require attention to interactions and dietary precautions.

### **Mapatumumab**

A medical term referring to mapatumumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Marburgvirus**

marburgvirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Marek's Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving marek's disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Margaric Acid**

margaric acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Marginal Ulcer**

An ulcer occurring at or near a gastrojejunal anastomosis, often after gastric bypass or other gastric surgery, where acid, ischemia, smoking, nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, or other factors may contribute.

### **Maribavir**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called maribavir. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Marimastat**

An investigational synthetic broad-spectrum inhibitor of matrix metalloproteinases, enzymes involved in extracellular-matrix breakdown, studied as a potential anticancer and anti-inflammatory drug.

### **Marine Toxin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving marine toxin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Marital Status**

A demographic or social-status variable describing whether a person is unmarried, married or partnered, separated, divorced, widowed, or in another legally or culturally recognized relationship; it may be relevant to social and health assessments.

### **Marital Therapy**

marital therapy is used in relation to marital therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Marked**

Pronounced, conspicuous, or substantially greater than usual; in a clinical report, the exact meaning depends on the finding and the comparison stan-

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dard.

### **Married**

Describing a person who is legally or socially joined to a spouse or partner; marital status is a demographic characteristic and does not by itself indicate health or relationship quality.

### **Marshall Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving marshall syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Masked Data**

Data altered, obscured, or replaced so that identifying values or sensitive details are hidden while selected analytical properties may be retained; masking is used to protect privacy and can be reversible or irreversible.

### **Masoprocrol**

A synthetic derivative of nordihydroguaiaretic acid that inhibits lipoxygenase pathways and has been investigated for topical treatment of actinic keratoses and for antineoplastic activity.

### **Mass Screening**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to mass screening. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Mass Spectrometer**

An instrument that ionizes chemical substances and separates or detects the resulting ions according to their mass-to-charge ratios, producing a mass spectrum.

### **Mass Spectrometry**

An analytical method that identifies and measures molecules by their mass-to-charge ratios; coupled with chromatography, it is widely used in clinical chemistry, toxicology, pharmacology, and proteomics.

### **Massage**

Manual manipulation of soft tissues using techniques such as stroking, kneading, or pressure, used for relaxation or symptom relief; it is not a substitute for diagnosis or treatment of an underlying disease.

### **Massage Therapy**

massage therapy is used in relation to massage therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Mast-Cell Sarcoma**

mast-cell sarcoma refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Masticate**

To chew food, using the teeth, tongue, and muscles of mastication to mechanically break it down and mix it with saliva before swallowing.

### **Masticatory Muscle**

One of the muscles that moves the mandible during chewing, chiefly the masseter, temporalis, medial pterygoid, and lateral pterygoid muscles.

### **Mastocytoma**

A localized collection or tumor of mast cells, usually presenting in the skin as a solitary cutaneous mastocytoma; rubbing the lesion can cause itching, redness, or swelling from mediator release.

### **Material**

Any substance or matter, including a tissue, specimen, biological product, implant, or foreign body, considered in a medical or scientific context.

### **Maternal**

Maternal means relating to a mother or the pregnant person, especially in connection with pregnancy, childbirth, or postpartum health.

### **Maternal Age**

Maternal age is the age of the pregnant person and

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can influence fertility, pregnancy risks, screening choices, and obstetric care.

### **Maternal Mortality**

Maternal mortality is death during pregnancy or within the defined postpartum period from a pregnancy-related cause, measured as a population health indicator.

### **Maternal Obesity**

A clinical condition involving maternal Obesity; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Mathematics**

The study of numbers, quantities, patterns, structures, and logical relationships; it supports medical statistics, modeling, imaging, epidemiology, and quantitative research.

### **Mating**

Sexual pairing or reproduction between organisms that permits exchange or transfer of gametes and may lead to fertilization.

### **Matrix Band**

A thin dental strip placed around a prepared tooth to temporarily replace a missing wall and contain restorative material while a filling or crown buildup is formed.

### **Matrix Metalloproteinase**

matrix metalloproteinase is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Mature Teratoma**

A germ-cell tumor composed of well-differentiated tissues from one or more embryonic germ layers; many are benign, but behavior depends on the site, age, and tumor type, and some can undergo malignant transformation.

### **Matuzumab**

A medical term referring to matuzumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Maxillary Sinus**

The maxillary sinus is a paired, air-filled cavity in the maxilla beneath each orbit. It drains into the nasal cavity and may become inflamed or infected in sinusitis.

### **Maximum**

The maximum is the greatest value in a set of measurements or the highest level reached by a variable, such as a recorded temperature, blood pressure, or drug concentration.

### **Maximum Thickness**

Maximum thickness is the greatest measured thickness of a structure or specimen. It may be reported in imaging, pathology, or assessment of a lesion, organ, or tissue layer.

### **Maytansine**

Maytansine is a potent antimetabolic compound that binds tubulin and inhibits microtubule assembly. Its derivatives are used as cytotoxic payloads in some antibody–drug conjugates.

### **Mazindol**

Mazindol is a sympathomimetic appetite suppressant that affects central catecholamine signaling. It has been used for short-term obesity treatment in some countries and may cause stimulant-related adverse effects.

### **Mcc Gene**

mcc gene is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **MCF-7 Cell**

MCF-7 cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related



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disease or injury.

### **Mead Acid**

mead acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Mean**

The mean is the arithmetic average, calculated by adding all values and dividing by the number of values. It is commonly used to summarize clinical measurements but can be distorted by extreme values.

### **Mean Diameter**

Mean diameter is the average diameter of a structure or lesion, usually calculated from one or more measured dimensions. The method used should be specified when measurements are clinically compared.

### **Mean Thickness**

Mean thickness is the average thickness calculated from multiple measurements of a tissue, structure, or specimen. It is used in imaging, pathology, and physiologic measurements.

### **Measles Vaccine**

Measles vaccine is a live attenuated vaccine that induces active immunity against measles virus. It is usually given as part of the measles–mumps–rubella (MMR) or measles–mumps–rubella–varicella (MMRV) vaccine.

### **Mecamylamine**

Mecamylamine is an orally active ganglionic nicotinic-receptor blocker that reduces sympathetic nerve transmission and lowers blood pressure. It has been used for severe hypertension and may cause postural hypotension, dizziness, constipation, and dry mouth.

### **Mecarazole**

Mecarazole is a synonym for carbendazim, a benzimidazole fungicide that interferes with fungal mi-

crotubule formation. It is an agricultural chemical rather than a routine human medicine and may be toxic if exposure occurs.

### **Mechanical Ventilator**

A mechanical ventilator is a machine that supports or replaces spontaneous breathing by delivering controlled or assisted breaths, usually through a mask or an endotracheal tube. Settings are adjusted to oxygenation, ventilation, mechanics, and patient needs.

### **Mechanoreceptor**

mechanoreceptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Mechlorethamine**

Mechlorethamine is an alkylating antineoplastic agent that cross-links DNA and inhibits cell division. Topical gel is used for cutaneous T-cell lymphoma; systemic use is limited by toxicities such as myelosuppression and tissue injury.

### **Meclizine**

Meclizine is a first-generation antihistamine with anticholinergic and vestibular-suppressant effects. It is used to prevent or treat motion sickness and vertigo and may cause drowsiness, dry mouth, and blurred vision.

### **Medial Meniscus**

The medial meniscus is a crescent-shaped fibrocartilage pad between the medial femoral condyle and medial tibial plateau. It distributes load and contributes to knee stability; tears may cause joint-line pain, swelling, or locking.

### **Mediastinal Cyst**

A mediastinal cyst is a fluid- or tissue-filled cystic lesion in the mediastinum. Common types include bronchogenic, thymic, and pericardial cysts; symptoms depend on size and compression, and imaging guides evaluation.

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## Mediastinal Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving mediastinal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Mediastinal Emphysema

Mediastinal emphysema, or pneumomediastinum, is the presence of free air in the mediastinum. It can follow alveolar rupture, trauma, surgery, or esophageal injury and may cause chest pain, neck crepitus, or respiratory compromise.

## Mediastinal Hemorrhage

A clinical condition or finding involving mediastinal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Mediastinal Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving mediastinal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Mediastinal Pleura

The mediastinal pleura is the portion of parietal pleura lining the lateral surfaces of the mediastinum. It separates the mediastinal contents from the pleural cavity and reflects around the lung root.

## Mediastinal Shift

Mediastinal shift is displacement of the mediastinal structures away from their usual position. It may result from increased pressure on one side, such as a tension pneumothorax, or loss of volume on the other, such as lung collapse.

## Mediastinoscopes

Mediastinoscopes are slender endoscopic instruments used during mediastinoscopy to inspect the mediastinum and obtain tissue samples, especially from mediastinal lymph nodes. The procedure is performed through a small incision near the sternum.

## Medical Device

A medical device is an instrument, apparatus, im-

plant, software, or similar article intended for diagnosis, prevention, monitoring, treatment, or alleviation of disease or injury. Its primary action is not achieved by chemical or metabolic means.

## Medical Economics

Medical economics is the study of how health-care resources are produced, distributed, financed, and used. It evaluates costs, outcomes, efficiency, access, and value in health-care decisions.

## Medical History

A medical history is a structured account of a person's current concerns, past illnesses and operations, medications, allergies, family history, social history, and relevant exposures. It helps guide examination, diagnosis, and treatment.

## Medical Indigency

Medical indigency is inability to obtain needed medical care because of insufficient financial resources or lack of adequate coverage. The term describes a social and economic circumstance, not a disease.

## Medical Pin

A medical pin is a slender metal fixation device inserted into bone or across a joint to stabilize a fracture or support orthopedic treatment. Pins may be temporary or permanent and require monitoring for infection and displacement.

## Medical Record

A medical record is the documented account of a patient's health information, including history, findings, diagnoses, test results, treatments, and clinical decisions. It supports continuity, communication, quality improvement, and legal documentation.

## Meditation

Meditation is a practice of intentionally directing attention, often toward the breath, a sensation, or an object, while observing thoughts without judgment. It may promote relaxation and stress management but does not replace indicated medical treatment.

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## Medroxyprogesterone

Medroxyprogesterone is a progestogen used for contraception, abnormal uterine bleeding, endometriosis, and hormone therapy; depot injections may cause irregular bleeding, weight change, delayed fertility return, and reduced bone density.

## Medroxyprogesterone Acetate

Medroxyprogesterone acetate is a synthetic progestin used in hormonal contraception, treatment of endometriosis or abnormal uterine bleeding, and hormone therapy. It suppresses ovulation and produces progestational effects; formulation-specific risks and contraindications apply.

## Medullary Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving medullary carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Medulloepithelioma

A medulloepithelioma is a rare embryonal tumor arising most often from the nonpigmented ciliary epithelium of the eye in children. It may cause visual symptoms, neovascular glaucoma, or a visible mass and is treated according to its extent and pathology.

## Mefenamic Acid

mefenamic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## Mefloquine

Mefloquine is an antimalarial drug used for prevention and treatment of susceptible malaria. It has a long half-life but can cause neuropsychiatric, vestibular, and cardiac adverse effects, so patient-specific contraindications and warnings are important.

## Megabecquerel

A megabecquerel (MBq) is a unit of radioactivity equal to one million nuclear disintegrations per second. It is used to state the activity of radiopharmaceuticals and other radioactive materials.

## Megacalycosis

Megacalycosis is congenital, nonobstructive dilatation of the renal calyces, usually with otherwise preserved renal architecture and function. It is often incidental but must be distinguished from obstructive hydronephrosis.

## Megakaryocytopoiesis

Megakaryocytopoiesis is the formation and maturation of megakaryocytes in the bone marrow, followed by platelet production. It is regulated in large part by thrombopoietin and other hematopoietic signals.

## Megamonas

Megamonas is a genus of anaerobic, gram-negative bacteria found mainly in the intestinal microbiota of humans and animals. Some species have been recovered from clinical specimens, although their disease-causing role depends on the clinical setting.

## Megamonas Funiformis

Megamonas funiformis is an anaerobic bacterium of the genus Megamonas, commonly associated with the intestinal microbiota. Its detection in a clinical specimen requires interpretation alongside symptoms, specimen quality, and other microbiologic findings.

## Megamonas Hypermegale

Megamonas hypermegale is an anaerobic bacterium in the genus Megamonas, primarily associated with the gastrointestinal microbiota. Its presence in a specimen is interpreted in relation to the site, clinical symptoms, and other microbiologic results.

## Megasphaera

Megasphaera is a genus of anaerobic bacteria found in the oral cavity and gastrointestinal and genital microbiota. Species identification may be relevant in microbiome studies or when recovered from a clinical specimen.

## Megasphaera Elsdenii

Megasphaera elsdenii is an anaerobic bacterium commonly found in the rumen and other microbial communities. It ferments organic acids and is mainly of

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relevance in microbiology and animal or microbiome research.

### **Mega-Trial**

A mega-trial is a very large clinical trial designed to enroll enough participants to detect clinically important differences, including relatively uncommon outcomes or modest treatment effects.

### **Megestrol**

Megestrol is a synthetic progestin used in some settings to treat hormone-responsive cancers and, in certain formulations, anorexia or severe weight loss. It can cause glucocorticoid-like effects, thromboembolic risk, and adrenal suppression.

### **Megestrol Acetate**

Megestrol acetate is the acetate salt of the progestin megestrol. Depending on formulation and indication, it is used for advanced endometrial or breast cancer and for appetite stimulation in selected patients with severe weight loss.

### **Meiotic Recombination**

Meiotic recombination is exchange of DNA between homologous chromosomes during meiosis, usually through crossing over. It creates new combinations of alleles and contributes to genetic variation.

### **Melanocyte**

A melanocyte is a pigment-producing cell derived from the neural crest. It makes melanin in specialized organelles called melanosomes and transfers the pigment to neighboring keratinocytes, helping protect skin from ultraviolet radiation.

### **Melanocytic Nevus**

A melanocytic nevus is a usually benign, localized proliferation of melanocytes that appears as a macule, papule, or nodule. Changes in size, color, border, or symptoms may require assessment for atypia or melanoma.

### **Melanophore**

A melanophore is a pigment-containing cell, espe-

cially one in lower vertebrates, whose melanin granules can disperse or aggregate to alter visible coloration. In mammals, melanocytes are the principal melanin-producing cells.

### **Melanosome**

A melanosome is a specialized organelle in a melanocyte in which melanin is synthesized, stored, and transported. Melanosomes are transferred to keratinocytes and influence skin, hair, and eye pigmentation.

### **MELAS Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving melas syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Melatonin Receptor**

melatonin receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Melengestrol Acetate**

Melengestrol acetate is a synthetic progestin used primarily in veterinary medicine to suppress estrus and improve feed efficiency in cattle. It is not approved for use in humans.

### **Melitten**

Melitten, more commonly spelled melittin, is the principal peptide toxin in honeybee venom. It disrupts cell membranes and contributes to pain, inflammation, hemolysis, and other effects of envenomation.

### **Meloxicam**

Meloxicam is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug that inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes and reduces prostaglandin synthesis. It is used for pain and inflammation, but can cause gastrointestinal, renal, cardiovascular, and hypersensitivity adverse effects.

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## Memantine Hydrochloride

Memantine hydrochloride is an NMDA-receptor antagonist used to help manage moderate-to-severe Alzheimer disease. It reduces pathologic glutamate-mediated excitotoxicity; common adverse effects include dizziness, headache, constipation, and confusion.

## Membrane Channel

A membrane channel is a protein-forming pore across a cell membrane that permits selected ions or molecules to pass down an electrochemical or concentration gradient. Many channels are gated by voltage, ligands, or mechanical forces.

## Membrane Fusion

Membrane fusion is merging of two lipid bilayers into one continuous membrane. It is required for processes such as synaptic vesicle release, enveloped-virus entry, fertilization, and intracellular vesicle trafficking.

## Membrane Lipids

membrane lipids is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## Membrane Microdomain

A membrane microdomain is a small, specialized region of a cell membrane with a distinct composition of lipids and proteins. It can organize receptors, signaling molecules, transporters, and cytoskeletal interactions.

## Membrane Part

A membrane part is a structural or molecular component of a biological membrane, such as a lipid, protein, carbohydrate, channel, or receptor. These components determine membrane integrity, transport, signaling, and cell recognition.

## Membrane Protein

membrane protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute

to disease.

## Membrane Raft

A membrane raft is a cholesterol- and sphingolipid-enriched membrane microdomain that helps cluster selected proteins and signaling molecules. Raft organization is dynamic and may change during receptor signaling or membrane trafficking.

## Memory Disorder

A clinical condition or finding involving memory disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Memory Impairment

Memory impairment is reduced ability to learn, store, retrieve, or recognize information. It may be transient or persistent and can result from normal aging, medications, sleep problems, neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, or other medical conditions.

## Memory Training

Memory training consists of structured exercises or strategies intended to improve encoding, storage, retrieval, or compensatory organization of information. Benefits vary by method and condition and do not establish treatment for an underlying disorder.

## Meningeal Carcinomatosis

A neoplasm involving meningeal carcinomatosis. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Meningeal Leukemia

A neoplasm involving meningeal leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Meningeal Lymphoma

A neoplasm involving meningeal lymphoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

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## Meningeal Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving meningeal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Meningism

Meningism is a syndrome of neck stiffness, headache, and sometimes photophobia or vomiting that resembles meningeal irritation without necessarily indicating meningitis. Serious causes, including infection or subarachnoid hemorrhage, require prompt evaluation.

## Menogaril

Menogaril is a semisynthetic anthracycline derivative of nogalamycin. It intercalates into DNA and inhibits topoisomerase II, thereby impairing DNA replication and repair; it was investigated as an antineoplastic agent.

## Menopause Status

Menopause status describes whether a person is premenopausal, perimenopausal, or postmenopausal. Natural menopause is clinically defined after 12 consecutive months without menstruation when no other cause explains the amenorrhea.

## Menotropin

Menotropin is a urinary-derived preparation containing follicle-stimulating and luteinizing hormone activity, used to stimulate follicular development or spermatogenesis; ovarian hyperstimulation and multiple pregnancy are important risks.

## Menses Duration

Menses duration is the number of days of menstrual bleeding in a cycle, counted from the first day of bleeding until bleeding stops. Persistently prolonged, heavy, or irregular bleeding warrants clinical assessment.

## Menstruation Disturbance

A menstruation disturbance is an abnormality in the timing, regularity, duration, amount, or associated symptoms of menstrual bleeding. Causes include pregnancy, endocrine disorders, structural disease,

medications, systemic illness, and perimenopause.

## Mental Disorders

A clinical condition or finding involving mental disorders. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Mental Fatigue

Mental fatigue is a subjective feeling of reduced mental energy, concentration, or cognitive endurance after sustained effort or illness. Persistent or severe symptoms may accompany sleep disorders, depression, neurologic disease, medication effects, or other medical conditions.

## Mental Process

A mental process is a cognitive or affective activity of the mind, such as perception, attention, memory, reasoning, language, emotion, or decision-making.

## Mental Recall

Mental recall is retrieval of previously learned or stored information from memory. It may be assessed by asking a person to remember facts, events, words, or experiences after a delay.

## Meperidine Hydrochloride

Meperidine hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of the opioid analgesic meperidine. It produces analgesia through opioid-receptor activity and carries risks of sedation, respiratory depression, seizures, dependence, and serotonin toxicity with interacting drugs.

## Mephenytoin

Mephenytoin is a hydantoin anticonvulsant formerly used to treat seizures. It is metabolized partly to ethotoin and has limited modern use because of potentially serious adverse effects, including hypersensitivity and blood dyscrasias.

## Merkel Cells

merkel cells refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related



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disease or injury.

### **Meropenem**

Meropenem is a broad-spectrum carbapenem antibiotic that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats severe susceptible infections, including meningitis; allergy, gastrointestinal effects, seizures, and resistance are possible.

### **Mersalyl**

Mersalyl is an organomercury compound formerly used as a diuretic. Because mercury compounds can cause serious renal and neurologic toxicity, it has been replaced by safer diuretics.

### **Mesalamine**

Mesalamine, or 5-aminosalicylic acid, is an anti-inflammatory drug used to induce and maintain remission in ulcerative colitis and some other inflammatory bowel conditions. It acts mainly topically in the intestinal mucosa and can rarely affect renal function.

### **Mesangiolytic**

Mesangiolytic is dissolution or disruption of the mesangial tissue within a renal glomerulus. It may occur in severe endothelial injury and can be associated with microvascular lesions and glomerular capillary aneurysmal changes.

### **Mesangium**

The mesangium is the supportive tissue between glomerular capillary loops, composed of mesangial cells and extracellular matrix. Mesangial cells provide structural support, regulate capillary flow, and clear certain substances; abnormal expansion occurs in several glomerular diseases.

### **Mesencephalon**

The mesencephalon, or midbrain, is the part of the brainstem between the pons and diencephalon. It contains pathways and nuclei involved in eye movements, motor control, arousal, and auditory and visual reflexes.

### **Mesenchymal Cell**

mesenchymal cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Mesenchymal Chondrosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving mesenchymal chondrosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Mesenchymoma**

A mesenchymoma is a rare tumor containing more than one type of mesenchymal tissue, sometimes including cartilage, bone, fat, or vascular elements. Behavior depends on the site, age, histology, and presence of malignant components.

### **Mesenteric Artery**

A mesenteric artery supplies blood to portions of the intestine and associated abdominal organs. The superior and inferior mesenteric arteries are the major vessels; obstruction or embolism can cause acute mesenteric ischemia.

### **Mesenteric Cyst**

A mesenteric cyst is a fluid-filled cystic lesion within the mesentery. It may be congenital, lymphatic, enteric, or traumatic; symptoms depend on size and complications such as infection, hemorrhage, torsion, or bowel obstruction.

### **Mesenteric Veins**

Mesenteric veins drain blood from the small and large intestines and carry it mainly through the superior and inferior mesenteric veins to the portal venous system. Thrombosis or impaired flow can cause intestinal congestion and ischemia.

### **Mesial Surface**

The mesial surface is the surface of a tooth or other structure oriented toward the midline. In dentistry, mesial surfaces contact adjacent teeth and can be involved in caries, periodontal disease, or restoration margins.

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## Mesna

Mesna is a sulfhydryl-containing uroprotective drug that binds the toxic acrolein metabolite of ifosfamide and cyclophosphamide in the urine. It is used to reduce hemorrhagic cystitis during treatment with these oxazaphosphorine chemotherapy agents.

## Mesonephric

Mesonephric means relating to the mesonephros, a temporary embryonic kidney, or to structures derived from its ducts and tubules. Mesonephric remnants can give rise to uncommon benign or malignant lesions of the genital tract.

## Mesonephric Tumor

A neoplasm involving mesonephric tumor. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Mesonephroma

Mesonephroma is an older, context-dependent term for a tumor formerly thought to arise from mesonephric remnants, including some clear-cell or mesonephric tumors of the female genital tract and historically some yolk-sac tumors. Modern pathology uses more specific diagnostic names.

## Mesothelial Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving mesothelial neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Mesothelin

Mesothelin is a cell-surface glycoprotein expressed mainly by mesothelial cells and overexpressed in several cancers, including mesothelioma and some ovarian and pancreatic cancers. It is being studied as a biomarker and therapeutic target.

## Mesothelium

The mesothelium is a single layer of specialized cells lining serous body cavities and covering their organs, including the pleura, peritoneum, and pericardium. It produces lubricating fluid and participates in inflammation and repair.

## Metabolic Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving metabolic disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Metabolic Response

A metabolic response is a change in energy use, substrate metabolism, or biochemical pathways in response to conditions such as fasting, exercise, infection, trauma, or medication. The response may be adaptive or contribute to illness when excessive or prolonged.

## Metabolomics

Metabolomics is the comprehensive study of small-molecule metabolites in cells, tissues, or biological fluids. It uses analytical methods such as mass spectrometry or nuclear magnetic resonance to investigate physiology, disease, and treatment effects.

## Metacarpal Bone

A metacarpal bone is one of the five long bones of the hand between the wrist bones and the proximal phalanges. Each has a base, shaft, and head; fractures can affect alignment, grip, and joint function.

## Metadata

Metadata is information describing other data, such as its source, format, time, units, author, processing history, or quality. In health care it helps identify, interpret, exchange, and govern clinical and research data.

## Metagenome

A metagenome is the total genetic material recovered from a microbial community or other mixed biological sample, including genomes from organisms that may not be cultured.

## Metagenomics

Metagenomics is the study of genetic material collected directly from an environmental or clinical sample containing multiple organisms. It can characterize microbial composition and functional genes without isolating each organism in culture.

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### **Metagonimus Yokogawai**

Metagonimus yokogawai is a small intestinal fluke acquired by eating raw or inadequately cooked freshwater fish. Infection can cause abdominal symptoms and, rarely, ectopic migration of eggs or adult worms.

### **Metal**

A metal is an element or alloy with characteristic physical and chemical properties such as electrical conductivity and metallic bonding. In medicine, metals may be nutrients, toxic exposures, laboratory analytes, or components of implants and devices.

### **Metalloendopeptidase**

A metalloendopeptidase is an endopeptidase whose catalytic activity depends on a bound metal ion, commonly zinc. It cleaves peptide bonds within proteins and includes enzymes involved in extracellular matrix remodeling and signaling.

### **Metalloporphyrins**

Metalloporphyrins are porphyrin molecules containing a centrally coordinated metal ion. Heme, which contains iron, is a biologically important example and forms the functional group of hemoglobin, myoglobin, and many enzymes.

### **Metalloprotease**

A metalloprotease is a proteolytic enzyme that requires a metal ion, commonly zinc, for catalytic activity. Metalloproteases regulate extracellular matrix turnover, cell signaling, inflammation, and tissue remodeling; dysregulation contributes to disease.

### **Metalloprotein**

metalloprotein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Metallothionein**

Metallothionein is a small, cysteine-rich protein that binds metals such as zinc, copper, and cadmium.

It helps regulate essential metals and may protect cells from metal toxicity and oxidative stress.

### **Metamorphosis**

Metamorphosis is a major change in body form during development, especially the transition from larva to adult in insects or other animals.

### **Metanephrine**

Metanephrine is a metabolite of epinephrine formed mainly by catechol-O-methyltransferase. Plasma or urinary metanephrine measurements are used in evaluation for catecholamine-secreting tumors such as pheochromocytoma and paraganglioma.

### **Metaphase Plate**

The metaphase plate is the plane at the center of a dividing cell where chromosomes align during metaphase. It is a geometric arrangement rather than a discrete anatomical structure.

### **Metaphyseal Widening**

Metaphyseal widening is enlargement of the growth-plate or metaphyseal region of a developing long bone. It may be seen in disorders such as rickets, skeletal dysplasia, infection, or healing injury and must be interpreted with imaging and clinical findings.

### **Metaplastic Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving metaplastic carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Metapneumovirus**

metapneumovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Metastin**

Metastin is an older name for kisspeptin, a peptide derived from the KISS1 gene. It stimulates hypothalamic gonadotropin-releasing hormone secretion and

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helps regulate puberty, reproductive function, and tumor-cell signaling.

### **Metatarsal Bone**

A metatarsal bone is one of the five long bones of the forefoot between the tarsal bones and proximal phalanges. Metatarsal fractures and alignment abnormalities can affect weight bearing and gait.

### **Metatarsal Valgus**

Metatarsal valgus is outward deviation of one or more metatarsal bones relative to the foot's normal axis. It may contribute to forefoot deformity and altered load distribution and is assessed clinically and radiographically.

### **Metatarsus Varus**

Metatarsus varus is inward deviation of the forefoot caused by medial angulation of the metatarsal bones. It is often recognized in infancy and may be flexible or rigid; management depends on severity and persistence.

### **Metencephalon**

The metencephalon is the embryonic brain region that develops into the pons and cerebellum. These structures participate in motor coordination, balance, cranial-nerve functions, and relay of signals between the brain and spinal cord.

### **Metestrus**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to metestrus. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Metformin**

Metformin is a biguanide antihyperglycemic drug that lowers hepatic glucose production and improves insulin sensitivity. It is commonly used for type 2 diabetes; gastrointestinal effects are common, and rare lactic acidosis risk increases with certain severe conditions.

### **Metformin Hydrochloride**

Metformin hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt

of metformin, an oral biguanide used chiefly for type 2 diabetes. It lowers blood glucose without directly stimulating pancreatic insulin release and is available in immediate- and extended-release formulations.

### **Methacholine Chloride**

Methacholine chloride is a muscarinic cholinergic agonist used in bronchoprovocation testing. In susceptible people it causes airway narrowing, allowing assessment for bronchial hyperresponsiveness under controlled medical supervision.

### **Methadone Hydrochloride**

Methadone hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of methadone. It provides long-lasting opioid-receptor activity for selected analgesic and opioid-use-disorder indications, with risks of respiratory depression, dependence, overdose, and cardiac arrhythmia.

### **Methamidophos**

Methamidophos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause cholinergic poisoning with sweating, salivation, vomiting, bronchospasm, bradycardia, muscle weakness, and potentially respiratory failure.

### **Methamphetamine**

Methamphetamine is a potent central nervous system stimulant that increases synaptic catecholamines. It has limited medical use in some settings but is commonly misused; toxicity and chronic use can cause cardiovascular complications, psychosis, dependence, and neurocognitive harm.

### **Methane**

Methane is a colorless, odorless, highly flammable gas produced by anaerobic decomposition and normal intestinal microbial activity. It can displace oxygen in enclosed spaces and cause asphyxiation; it is not itself a direct systemic poison at ordinary exposure levels.

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## **Methane Sulfonate**

Methane sulfonate, or mesylate, is the anion or ester derived from methanesulfonic acid. Mesylate salts are commonly used to improve the formulation of medicines; some methanesulfonate esters are potent alkylating agents and toxic impurities.

## **Methanobacteriaceae**

methanobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Methaqualone**

Methaqualone is a sedative-hypnotic formerly used for insomnia and anxiety. It is no longer widely marketed because of misuse, dependence, dangerous respiratory and central nervous system depression, and overdose risk.

## **Methazolamide**

Methazolamide is a carbonic anhydrase inhibitor used mainly to lower intraocular pressure in glaucoma. It reduces aqueous humor production and can cause metabolic acidosis, electrolyte abnormalities, kidney stones, or sulfonamide-related reactions.

## **Methenamine**

Methenamine is a urinary antiseptic that decomposes in acidic urine to release formaldehyde, which inhibits bacterial growth. It is used for prevention of recurrent urinary tract infection in selected patients, not for treatment of active upper-tract infection.

## **Methidathion**

Methidathion is an organophosphorus insecticide and acaricide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can produce a cholinergic toxidrome with secretions, bronchospasm, bradycardia, gastrointestinal symptoms, weakness, and respiratory failure.

## **Methiocarb**

Methiocarb is a carbamate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase reversibly. Poisoning causes excessive muscarinic and nicotinic cholinergic ac-

tivity and may require urgent supportive care and antidotal treatment.

## **Methionine Enkephalin**

Methionine enkephalin is an endogenous opioid pentapeptide that binds opioid receptors and participates in modulation of pain, stress, reward, and neuroendocrine function. It is one of the products of proenkephalin processing.

## **Methocarbamol**

Methocarbamol is a centrally acting skeletal-muscle relaxant used with rest and physical measures for acute painful musculoskeletal conditions. It can cause drowsiness, dizziness, impaired coordination, and additive central nervous system depression.

## **Methodology**

Methodology is the systematic set of principles, methods, procedures, and assumptions used to conduct and evaluate an investigation or clinical study. Sound methodology addresses design, measurement, bias, analysis, and reproducibility.

## **Methohexital**

Methohexital is an ultra-short-acting barbiturate anesthetic used for induction of general anesthesia and, in selected settings, procedural sedation. It depresses central nervous system activity and may cause respiratory or cardiovascular depression.

## **Methomyl**

Methomyl is a carbamate insecticide that reversibly inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Poisoning produces cholinergic symptoms such as salivation, sweating, vomiting, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, and respiratory compromise.

## **Methotrimeprazine**

Methotrimeprazine, also called levomepromazine, is a phenothiazine with antipsychotic, sedative, antiemetic, and analgesic properties. It is used in some countries for psychiatric illness and palliative-care symptoms and can cause sedation, hypotension, and anticholinergic effects.



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## Methoxamine

Methoxamine is a predominantly alpha-adrenergic agonist that increases vascular tone and blood pressure. It has been used as a vasopressor for hypotension but is not a routine first-line agent in many current practice settings.

## Methoxsalen

Methoxsalen is a psoralen that intercalates into DNA and, after exposure to UVA, forms cross-links that suppress abnormal lymphocyte or skin-cell activity. It is used with UVA phototherapy for selected skin diseases; photosensitivity and skin-cancer risk require precautions.

## Methoxyamine Hydrochloride

Methoxyamine hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of methoxyamine, a sympathomimetic compound with predominantly alpha-adrenergic activity. It has been used experimentally or historically as a vasopressor and pharmacologic probe.

## Methoxyhydroxyphenylglycol

Methoxyhydroxyphenylglycol (MHPG) is a major metabolite of norepinephrine. Measurement in blood, urine, or cerebrospinal fluid has been used in research and selected neuroendocrine evaluations of sympathetic or central noradrenergic activity.

## Methyclothiazide

Methyclothiazide is a thiazide diuretic that inhibits sodium and chloride reabsorption in the distal convoluted tubule. It is used for hypertension or edema and may cause hypokalemia, hyponatremia, hyperuricemia, and glucose intolerance.

## Methyl Bromide

Methyl bromide, or bromomethane, is a volatile fumigant and alkylating chemical. Inhalation can cause severe neurologic, respiratory, renal, and cardiovascular toxicity, including delayed seizures and pulmonary edema.

## Methyl Chloride

Methyl chloride, or chloromethane, is a volatile industrial gas formerly used in refrigerants and other

applications. High-level inhalation exposure can depress the central nervous system and cause headache, ataxia, seizures, or cardiac effects.

## Methyl Green

Methyl green is a cationic dye used in histology, often to stain DNA and nuclei. It is a laboratory reagent rather than a therapeutic drug, and handling should follow appropriate chemical-safety procedures.

## Methyl Group

A methyl group is a chemical group consisting of one carbon atom bonded to three hydrogen atoms, written  $-CH_3$ . Methyl transfer reactions are important in metabolism, epigenetic regulation, and drug biotransformation.

## Methyl Isocyanate

Methyl isocyanate is a highly volatile and reactive industrial chemical. Inhalation or eye and skin exposure can cause severe irritation, pulmonary edema, and delayed respiratory injury; it was the toxic agent in the Bhopal disaster.

## Methyl Methanesulfonate

Methyl methanesulfonate is an alkylating agent that methylates DNA and other cellular molecules. It is used experimentally to induce mutagenesis and is hazardous because of its genotoxic and carcinogenic potential.

## Methyl Parathion

Methyl parathion is an organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can produce severe cholinergic poisoning with secretions, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

## Methylcholanthrene

Methylcholanthrene is a polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbon used experimentally as a carcinogen. It can form reactive metabolites that damage DNA and is used in research on tumor initiation and chemical carcinogenesis.



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## **Methylene Chloride**

Methylene chloride, or dichloromethane, is a volatile industrial solvent. Inhalation can cause central nervous system depression and metabolism to carbon monoxide can produce tissue hypoxia; high exposure may be fatal.

## **Methylguanidine**

Methylguanidine is a guanidine compound formed during protein and amino-acid metabolism. It can accumulate in advanced kidney failure and is studied as a uremic toxin that may contribute to oxidative and cellular injury.

## **Methylmalonic Aciduria**

methylmalonic aciduria is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## **Methylmercury Compounds**

Methylmercury compounds are organic mercury compounds that can accumulate in aquatic food chains and cross the blood–brain and placental barriers. Exposure primarily injures the nervous system and can impair fetal neurodevelopment.

## **Methylmethacrylate**

Methyl methacrylate is a volatile monomer used to make acrylic plastics and dental or orthopedic bone cement. Vapors may irritate the eyes and airways, and liquid exposure can cause dermatitis or sensitization.

## **Methylnaltrexone**

Methylnaltrexone is a peripherally acting mu-opioid-receptor antagonist used to treat opioid-induced constipation when laxatives are insufficient. It generally preserves central analgesia but can cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, and rarely gastrointestinal perforation.

## **Methylnaltrexone Bromide**

Methylnaltrexone bromide is the bromide salt of methylnaltrexone, a peripherally restricted opioid antagonist. It reverses opioid effects in the gas-

trointestinal tract and is used for opioid-induced constipation under indication-specific precautions.

## **Methylnitrosourea**

Methylnitrosourea is a potent alkylating and mutagenic compound used experimentally to induce DNA damage and tumors. It is not a therapeutic drug and requires strict laboratory handling because of its carcinogenicity.

## **Methylobacteriaceae**

methylobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Methylobacterium**

methylobacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Methylthioinosine**

Methylthioinosine is a sulfur-containing purine nucleoside involved in cellular methylthio and purine metabolism. Its derivatives and related metabolites are studied in biochemical pathways and cancer biology rather than used routinely as medicines.

## **Methyltransferase**

A methyltransferase is an enzyme that transfers a methyl group from a donor, commonly S-adenosylmethionine, to DNA, RNA, proteins, lipids, or small molecules. Methylation can alter gene expression, protein activity, or metabolism.

## **Metolcarb**

Metolcarb is a carbamate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase. Exposure may cause cholinergic poisoning with excessive secretions, gastrointestinal symptoms, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, or respiratory compromise.

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## Metoprolol

Metoprolol is a relatively beta-1-selective blocker used for hypertension, angina, heart failure, rate control, and some post-infarction settings; bradycardia, hypotension, fatigue, and bronchospasm can occur.

## Metric System

The metric system is a decimal system of measurement based on units such as the meter, kilogram, and liter. Modern medicine generally uses the International System of Units (SI), with conventional units retained for some measurements.

## Metronomic Chemotherapy

metronomic chemotherapy is used in relation to metronomic chemotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Metschnikowia

A biomedical term referring to metschnikowia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Mevinphos

Mevinphos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can rapidly cause cholinergic crisis, including bronchorrhea, bronchospasm, muscle weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

## Mexacarbate

Mexacarbate is a carbamate insecticide that interferes with acetylcholinesterase. Toxic exposure may produce muscarinic and nicotinic cholinergic symptoms and requires prompt decontamination and medical evaluation.

## Mexiletine

Mexiletine is an oral class IB antiarrhythmic and sodium-channel blocker used for selected ventricular arrhythmias and sometimes neuropathic pain. It can cause gastrointestinal and neurologic effects and may worsen or provoke arrhythmias in some patients.

## Meyerozyma Guilliermondii

Meyerozyma guilliermondii is a yeast formerly classified as *Candida guilliermondii*. It is usually an environmental or colonizing organism but can cause opportunistic bloodstream or other infections, particularly in immunocompromised patients.

## Micelle

micelle refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## Microabscess

A microabscess is a small, localized collection of pus consisting of neutrophils, necrotic material, and microorganisms or inflammatory debris. It may occur in skin, glands, organs, or tissue affected by infection or inflammatory disease.

## Microarray Analysis

Microarray analysis measures the abundance or hybridization of many nucleic-acid sequences simultaneously using an array of immobilized probes. It can assess gene expression, copy-number changes, or selected genetic variants.

## Microbacterium

microbacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Microbial Biofilms

Microbial biofilms are organized communities of microorganisms attached to a surface and enclosed in a self-produced extracellular matrix. Biofilms can form on tissues and medical devices and often show increased tolerance to antimicrobials and host defenses.

## Microbicide

A microbicide is a chemical or biological agent that kills microorganisms or inactivates them. The term may refer to disinfectants, topical agents, or in-

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vestigational products intended to reduce sexual transmission of infection.

### **Microbody**

A microbody is a small membrane-bound cytoplasmic organelle, a term that includes peroxisomes and related organelles. Microbodies contain enzymes involved in oxidation, detoxification, and lipid metabolism.

### **Microchip Site**

A microchip site is the anatomical location where an implanted identification or monitoring microchip is placed, commonly in subcutaneous tissue. The site should be recorded for identification and assessed for migration, irritation, or infection when relevant.

### **Micrococcaceae**

Micrococcaceae is a family of generally gram-positive, catalase-positive cocci that includes *Micrococcus* and related genera. These organisms commonly inhabit skin and the environment, although some can cause opportunistic infection.

### **Micrococcus Luteus**

*Micrococcus luteus* is a gram-positive, aerobic coccus commonly present on human skin and in the environment. It is usually a contaminant or colonizer but can rarely cause bacteremia or device-associated infection in susceptible patients.

### **Micrococcus Lylae**

*Micrococcus lylae* is a gram-positive, aerobic coccus associated mainly with skin flora and environmental samples. Its recovery from a clinical specimen requires correlation with symptoms and the possibility of contamination or colonization.

### **Microcolon**

Microcolon is an abnormally small-caliber colon, often identified on contrast imaging. It may result from reduced fetal intestinal use or obstruction and is associated with conditions such as small-left-colon syndrome, meconium ileus, or distal intestinal obstruction.

### **Microcornea**

Microcornea is an abnormally small cornea, usually defined in adults by a horizontal diameter below about 10 mm. It may be isolated or associated with microphthalmia, glaucoma, cataract, or genetic syndromes.

### **Microcurie**

A microcurie ( $\mu\text{Ci}$ ) is a unit of radioactivity equal to one-millionth of a curie, or approximately 37 kilobecquerels. It may be used to express the activity of radioactive tracers or sources.

### **Microdialysis**

Microdialysis is a sampling technique in which a semipermeable probe perfused with fluid collects small molecules from extracellular tissue fluid. It can monitor local concentrations of metabolites or drugs, including in the brain or subcutaneous tissue.

### **Microdissection**

Microdissection is separation or isolation of very small tissue regions or structures under microscopic or highly magnified visualization. It is used in surgery, pathology, and molecular research to obtain selected cells or tissue.

### **Microelectrode**

A microelectrode is a very small electrode used to record electrical activity from, or deliver stimulation to, individual cells, nerves, or small tissue regions. It is common in electrophysiology and neuroscience research.

### **Microfibril**

A microfibril is a fine, threadlike structural unit composed of proteins such as fibrillin or cellulose, depending on the tissue. In connective tissue, microfibrils help organize elastic fibers and provide extracellular support.

### **Microfilament**

A microfilament is a thin cytoskeletal filament composed mainly of actin, about 7 nm in diameter. Microfilaments support cell shape, motility, contraction, cytokinesis, and intracellular transport.

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### Microfilament Proteins

microfilament proteins is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### Microfluidics

Microfluidics is the manipulation of very small volumes of fluid in channels or systems with dimensions typically in the micrometer range. It enables compact assays, cell sorting, diagnostics, and laboratory-on-a-chip devices.

### Microglandular Adenosis

Microglandular adenosis is an uncommon benign proliferation of small glands in the breast, often associated with hormonal influences such as pregnancy or progestin use. It can mimic invasive carcinoma and is diagnosed histologically.

### Microglia

Microglia are resident immune cells of the central nervous system. They survey neural tissue, remove debris, and respond to injury or infection; persistent activation can contribute to neuroinflammation.

### Microgliosis

Microgliosis is proliferation or increased activation of microglia in the central nervous system, usually in response to injury, infection, degeneration, or other inflammation. It is a histopathologic finding rather than a specific disease.

### Micrognathism

Micrognathism is abnormal smallness of the jaw, usually referring to the mandible. It may be congenital or acquired and can affect feeding, dentition, airway patency, speech, or facial development.

### Microinjection

Microinjection is delivery of a very small volume of fluid into a cell, tissue, or other microscopic target using a fine needle or micropipette. It is used in assisted reproduction, experimental biology, and some therapeutic procedures.

### Micromole

A micromole ( $\mu\text{mol}$ ) is an amount of substance equal to one-millionth of a mole, or approximately  $6.022 \times 10^{17}$  entities. It is commonly used for small quantities and concentrations of biochemical substances.

### Microneme

A microneme is a small secretory organelle in many apicomplexan parasites. It releases proteins that support host-cell attachment, motility, and invasion during the parasite life cycle.

### Micronization

Micronization is a process that reduces particles to micrometer-scale dimensions, often to increase surface area and improve dissolution or absorption of a drug. The resulting particle size and formulation still determine clinical performance.

### Micronutrient

A micronutrient is a vitamin or mineral required in small amounts for normal growth, metabolism, and physiologic function. Deficiency or excess can cause disease, and requirements vary with age, pregnancy, illness, and other factors.

### Microorganism Genetics

microorganism genetics is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### Micropexophagy

Micropexophagy is a form of selective autophagy in which a cell degrades peroxisomes by enclosing them in an autophagic structure and delivering them to the vacuole or lysosome. It is studied mainly in fungal and cellular biology.

### Microphthalmos

Microphthalmos, or microphthalmia, is congenital underdevelopment resulting in an abnormally small eye. It may be isolated or associated with orbital, retinal, lens, genetic, or systemic abnormalities and can substantially impair vision.

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## **Microradiography**

Microradiography is radiographic imaging of very small specimens or structures, often using high magnification and fine-detail techniques. It can demonstrate microarchitecture in bone, tissue, teeth, or experimental samples.

## **Microsome**

A microsome is a small membrane vesicle formed from fragments of endoplasmic reticulum when cells are disrupted and centrifuged. Microsomes are laboratory preparations used to study membrane enzymes, including drug-metabolizing cytochrome P450 systems.

## **Microspectrophotometry**

Microspectrophotometry measures the absorption or emission spectrum of a microscopic region or individual cell. It can quantify pigments, nucleic acids, proteins, or other chromophores in small biological samples.

## **Microsphere**

A microsphere is a small spherical particle, often made of polymer, glass, or another material, used in drug delivery, imaging, embolization, or laboratory assays. Its size, composition, and surface properties determine its biologic behavior.

## **Microspherophakia**

Microspherophakia is an abnormally small, spherical crystalline lens. It can occur in inherited disorders such as Weill–Marchesani syndrome and may cause lens displacement, pupillary block, angle-closure glaucoma, or reduced vision.

## **Microsporidia**

A biomedical term referring to microsporidia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## **Microsporidiosis**

A biomedical term referring to microsporidiosis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic con-

text.

## **Microsporium**

microsporium is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Microsporium Audouinii**

microsporium audouinii is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Microsporium Distortum**

microsporium distortum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Microsporium Equinum**

microsporium equinum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Microsporium Ferrugineum**

microsporium ferrugineum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Microsporium Gypseum**

microsporium gypseum is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

## **Microstomia**

Microstomia is abnormal narrowing or smallness of the mouth opening. It may be congenital or result from scarring, burns, surgery, trauma, or connective-tissue disease and can impair eating, speech, oral hygiene, and dental treatment.

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## Microsurgery

microsurgery is used in relation to microsurgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Microtechnology

Microtechnology is the design and manufacture of devices or structures with micrometer-scale features. Medical applications include microfluidic diagnostics, sensors, drug-delivery systems, and minimally invasive instruments.

## Microtubule

A microtubule is a hollow cytoskeletal polymer made of tubulin dimers. Microtubules maintain cell shape, organize intracellular transport, form the mitotic spindle, and support cilia and flagella.

## Microtubule Bundle

A microtubule bundle is an organized group of parallel or otherwise coordinated microtubules within a cell. Bundles provide structural support and guide transport or movement, including in axons, cilia, and dividing cells.

## Microvillus

A microvillus is a microscopic, actin-supported projection of a cell membrane that increases surface area. Microvilli are abundant on intestinal epithelial cells, where they support nutrient absorption, and on renal tubular cells.

## Microvolt

A microvolt ( $\mu\text{V}$ ) is one-millionth of a volt. It is used to express small bioelectric signals, such as those recorded by electroencephalography, electromyography, electrocardiography, or evoked-potential testing.

## Microwave Therapy

microwave therapy is used in relation to microwave therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Microwell Plate

A microwell plate is a laboratory plate containing an array of small wells used to hold separate samples or reactions. It supports high-throughput assays, cell culture, immunoassays, and biochemical testing.

## Midazolam

Midazolam is a short-acting benzodiazepine used for procedural sedation, anesthesia, and treatment of acute seizures in appropriate settings. It enhances GABA-A receptor activity and can cause profound sedation and respiratory depression, especially with opioids or other depressants.

## Midazolam Hydrochloride

Midazolam hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of the short-acting benzodiazepine midazolam. It is used for procedural sedation, anesthesia, and selected seizure emergencies and can cause dose-related sedation, hypotension, and respiratory depression.

## Middle Insomnia

Middle insomnia is repeated or prolonged awakening during the middle portion of the sleep period, often with difficulty returning to sleep. It may occur with stress, mood disorders, sleep apnea, pain, substances, medications, or other sleep disorders.

## Midodrine

Midodrine is an oral prodrug whose active metabolite stimulates alpha-1 adrenergic receptors and increases vascular tone. It is used for symptomatic orthostatic hypotension and may cause supine hypertension, piloerection, urinary retention, or scalp tingling.

## Midomafetamine

Midomafetamine is another name for 3,4-methylenedioxymethamphetamine (MDMA), a psychoactive amphetamine derivative. It is being studied in controlled psychotherapy-assisted research but can cause hyperthermia, hyponatremia, cardiovascular toxicity, serotonin toxicity, and misuse.



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## Midostaurin

Midostaurin is a multikinase inhibitor used with chemotherapy for newly diagnosed acute myeloid leukemia with a susceptible FLT3 mutation and for advanced systemic mastocytosis. It can cause nausea, cytopenias, infection, and other treatment-related toxicities.

## Mifepristone

Mifepristone is a progesterone-receptor antagonist and, at higher doses, a glucocorticoid-receptor antagonist. It is used with misoprostol for medication abortion under applicable protocols and for selected cases of hyperglycemia associated with Cushing syndrome.

## Mikulicz Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving mikulicz disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Milatuzumab

A medical term referring to milatuzumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Mild

Mild describes relatively low intensity, severity, or extent of a symptom, sign, disease, or abnormality. The meaning depends on the condition and the clinical scale used and does not by itself indicate that no treatment or evaluation is needed.

## Mile

A mile is a unit of distance equal to 1,609.344 meters. It may be used in descriptions of walking or running distance, although scientific and clinical measurements generally use SI units.

## Milieu Therapy

milieu therapy is used in relation to milieu therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Military Personnel

Military personnel are members of the armed forces, including active-duty, reserve, and related service members. Their health care may address occupational exposures, injuries, infectious risks, combat-related trauma, and deployment-related mental-health conditions.

## Millicurie

A millicurie (mCi) is one-thousandth of a curie, equal to approximately 37 megabecquerels. It is used to express the activity of radioactive sources and some radiopharmaceutical doses.

## Milliosmole

A milliosmole (mOsm) is one-thousandth of an osmole, a unit reflecting the number of osmotically active particles in a solution. Osmolality and osmolarity are commonly reported in mOsm/kg or mOsm/L.

## Millisecond

A millisecond (ms) is one-thousandth of a second. It is used to measure brief physiologic events, reaction times, nerve conduction intervals, and timing of electrical or imaging signals.

## Milliunit

A milliunit (mU) is one-thousandth of a unit of biologic or enzymatic activity. Because a unit is defined according to the substance or assay, the clinical meaning of a milliunit depends on the specific test or medication.

## Mineral Oil

Mineral oil is a purified mixture of liquid hydrocarbons derived from petroleum. It is used in some topical products, cosmetics, and laxatives; aspiration of liquid mineral oil can cause lipid pneumonia.

## Mineralocorticoid

A mineralocorticoid is a steroid hormone that regulates sodium, potassium, and extracellular-fluid balance, chiefly through receptors in the renal distal nephron. Aldosterone is the principal endogenous mineralocorticoid; excess causes hypertension and

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hypokalemia.

### **Minisatellite Repeat**

A minisatellite repeat is a tandemly repeated DNA sequence with repeat units commonly ranging from about 10 to 100 base pairs. Variation in repeat number can serve as a genetic marker and, in some loci, influence gene regulation or disease risk.

### **Minor Response**

A minor response is a limited improvement after treatment that does not meet the predefined criteria for a partial or complete response. The exact threshold depends on the disease, study protocol, and outcome being measured.

### **Minority Health**

Minority health concerns the health status, health determinants, access, quality of care, and outcomes of populations that experience social, economic, cultural, or structural marginalization. Differences in outcomes often reflect modifiable inequities rather than inherent biology.

### **Minretumomab**

A medical term referring to minretumomab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Miosis Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving miosis disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Mirage Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving mirage syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Mirex**

Mirex is a persistent organochlorine insecticide and industrial chemical. It bioaccumulates and is environmentally hazardous; exposure has been associated with toxic effects in experimental studies and is controlled or prohibited in many jurisdictions.

### **Mirtazapine**

Mirtazapine is a noradrenergic and specific serotonergic antidepressant used for major depressive disorder. It commonly causes sedation and increased appetite or weight and can rarely cause neutropenia or other serious adverse effects.

### **Misalignment**

Misalignment is abnormal positioning or orientation of two or more structures relative to their intended relationship. It may affect bones, joints, teeth, eyes, implants, or medical devices and can impair function or healing.

### **Misdiagnosis**

Misdiagnosis is assignment of an incorrect diagnosis or failure to recognize the correct condition. It can lead to inappropriate treatment, delayed care, avoidable harm, or unnecessary testing and may result from atypical presentation, incomplete information, or system factors.

### **Mismatch Repair**

Mismatch repair is a DNA-repair pathway that recognizes and corrects incorrectly paired bases or small insertion–deletion loops generated during replication. Defects in mismatch-repair genes cause microsatellite instability and increase risk of several cancers, including Lynch-syndrome cancers.

### **Misonidazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called misonidazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Missed Dose**

A missed dose is a scheduled dose of a medicine that was not taken or administered. The appropriate response depends on the drug and timing; doubling a dose can be dangerous, so the product instructions or a clinician or pharmacist should guide the next dose.

### **Missense Mutation**

A missense mutation is a DNA sequence change

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that substitutes one amino acid for another in a protein. Its effect may be harmful, beneficial, or neutral depending on the affected residue, protein function, and genetic context.

### Mitigate

To mitigate means to lessen the severity, impact, or likelihood of a symptom, risk, injury, or disease complication. Mitigation may involve prevention, treatment, environmental changes, or supportive care.

### Mitobronitol

Mitobronitol is an alkylating antineoplastic compound formerly investigated or used in selected hematologic malignancies. Its cytotoxic effects can damage DNA and cause myelosuppression and other treatment-related toxicities.

### Mitochondrial Cristae

Mitochondrial cristae are folds of the inner mitochondrial membrane that increase surface area for the electron-transport chain and ATP synthase. Their structure supports oxidative phosphorylation and changes with cellular energy demands.

### Mitochondrial DNA

A medical term referring to mitochondrial dna. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Mitochondrial Fission

Mitochondrial fission is division of one mitochondrion into two or more mitochondria. It helps distribute mitochondria, remove damaged portions through mitophagy, and respond to cell-cycle or metabolic signals; excessive fission may contribute to disease.

### Mitochondrial Fusion

Mitochondrial fusion is joining of mitochondria into a connected network. It permits exchange of mitochondrial contents and helps maintain bioenergetic function and genome integrity; fusion and fission are normally balanced dynamically.

### Mitochondrial Matrix

The mitochondrial matrix is the protein-rich compartment enclosed by the inner mitochondrial membrane. It contains mitochondrial DNA, ribosomes, and enzymes for the citric-acid cycle, fatty-acid oxidation, and other metabolic processes.

### Mitochondrial Membrane

The mitochondrial membrane system consists of an outer membrane and a highly folded inner membrane separated by an intermembrane space. It controls transport and houses the respiratory chain and ATP-producing machinery.

### Mitochondrial Ribosome

A mitochondrial ribosome is a ribosome within mitochondria that translates proteins encoded by mitochondrial DNA. Its structure differs from cytosolic ribosomes and defects in mitochondrial translation can cause energy-production disorders.

### Mitochondrial Swelling

A medical term referring to mitochondrial swelling. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Mitochondrion

A mitochondrion is a membrane-bound organelle that generates much of a cell's ATP through oxidative phosphorylation. It also participates in apoptosis, calcium handling, metabolism, and production or regulation of reactive oxygen species.

### Mitogen

A mitogen is a substance that stimulates a cell, especially a lymphocyte, to enter the cell cycle and proliferate. Mitogens include growth factors, lectins, and other signals that activate proliferative pathways.

### Mitoguazone

Mitoguazone, also called methylglyoxal bis(guanyldrazone), is an experimental antineoplastic agent that interferes with polyamine metabolism and cell proliferation. It has been investigated in hematologic and other cancers.

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## Mitolactol

Mitolactol is an alkylating antineoplastic compound formerly used or investigated in cancer treatment. It damages DNA and can cause cytotoxic effects such as myelosuppression and gastrointestinal toxicity.

## Mitomycin

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called mitomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## Mitomycins

Mitomycins are antitumor antibiotics that become activated in cells and cross-link DNA, inhibiting replication and transcription. Mitomycin C is the best-known member and is used in selected cancers and ophthalmic or surgical applications.

## Mitophagy

Mitophagy is selective autophagic removal of damaged, excess, or otherwise targeted mitochondria. It maintains mitochondrial quality and cellular homeostasis; impaired or excessive mitophagy is implicated in some neurodegenerative and metabolic disorders.

## Mitosporic Fungi

mitosporic fungi is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mitotane

Mitotane is an adrenolytic drug used for selected adrenocortical carcinomas and to suppress excess adrenal steroid production. It can cause gastrointestinal and neurologic effects, adrenal insufficiency, and numerous drug interactions.

## Mitotic Anaphase

Mitotic anaphase is the stage of mitosis in which sister chromatids separate and move toward opposite poles of the cell. Accurate spindle attachment and chromosome segregation are required for formation

of genetically similar daughter cells.

## Mitotic Metaphase

Mitotic metaphase is the stage of mitosis in which duplicated chromosomes align at the cell equator with sister kinetochores attached to opposite spindle poles. A checkpoint helps prevent premature chromosome separation.

## Mitotic Prophase

Mitotic prophase is the early stage of mitosis in which chromatin condenses into visible chromosomes, the nucleolus disappears, and the mitotic spindle begins to form. In late prophase or prometaphase, the nuclear envelope breaks down.

## Mitotic Recombination

Mitotic recombination is exchange or rearrangement of DNA between homologous chromosomes during or around mitotic cell division. It can repair DNA or generate loss of heterozygosity and is relevant to tumor evolution and genetic disease.

## Mitotic Telophase

Mitotic telophase is the stage after chromosome separation when chromosomes reach opposite poles, decondense, and become enclosed in newly forming nuclear envelopes. Cytokinesis usually follows or overlaps with telophase.

## Mitoxantrone

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving mitoxantrone; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

## Mitral Valvuloplasty

mitral valvuloplasty is used in relation to mitral valvuloplasty during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Mitsuokella

mitsuokella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather

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than colonization.

### **Mitsuokella Multacida**

A biomedical term referring to mitsuokella multacida; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mixed Glioma**

Mixed glioma is an older term for a glial tumor showing features of more than one glial lineage, historically including oligoastrocytoma. Modern classification relies mainly on molecular findings and generally assigns such tumors to a more specific entity.

### **Mobile Health Unit**

A mobile health unit is a vehicle or transportable facility equipped to provide health services at changing locations. It may deliver screening, vaccination, primary care, diagnostic testing, emergency support, or outreach to underserved communities.

### **Mobiluncus**

A biomedical term referring to mobiluncus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mobiluncus Curtisii**

A biomedical term referring to mobiluncus curtisii; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mobiluncus Mulieris**

A biomedical term referring to mobiluncus mulieris; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mocetinostat**

Mocetinostat is an investigational histone deacetylase inhibitor studied as an antineoplastic agent. By altering histone acetylation and gene expression, it may inhibit tumor-cell growth; clinical use depends

on regulatory approval and indication.

### **Moderation**

Moderation is reduction or control of the intensity, amount, or severity of a process, symptom, behavior, or treatment effect. In clinical research, a moderator is a factor that changes the strength or direction of an association.

### **Moellerella**

moellerella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moellerella Wisconsinensis**

A biomedical term referring to moellerella wisconsinensis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Mogibacterium**

mogibacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Molecular Chaperone**

A molecular chaperone is a protein that assists other proteins with folding, assembly, transport, or refolding without becoming part of the final structure. Chaperones can also help prevent or resolve protein aggregation.

### **Molecular Diagnosis**

Molecular diagnosis uses analysis of DNA, RNA, proteins, or other molecular markers to identify a disease, pathogen, inherited variant, tumor subtype, or treatment-relevant characteristic. Results require appropriate assay validation and clinical interpretation.

### **Molecular Dynamic**

Molecular dynamics is a computational method that

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simulates movement and interactions of atoms or molecules over time using physical force fields. It is used to study biomolecular structure, flexibility, binding, and drug interactions.

### **Molecular Imaging**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to molecular imaging. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Molecular Medicine**

Molecular medicine applies molecular and cellular biology to understand, diagnose, prevent, and treat disease. It includes genomics, precision oncology, molecular biomarkers, targeted therapy, and other mechanism-based approaches.

### **Molecular Probe**

A molecular probe is a labeled or otherwise detectable molecule designed to bind a particular nucleic-acid sequence, protein, metabolite, or other target. Probes are used in imaging, assays, microscopy, and molecular diagnostics.

### **Molecular Response**

A molecular response is a measurable change in a molecular marker, such as a pathogen load, oncogenic transcript, mutation burden, or biomarker, after disease progression or treatment. Its definition and clinical significance depend on the disease and assay.

### **Mollusca**

mollusca is a parasitic or invertebrate taxon; its medical relevance depends on the species, life cycle, exposure, host, and site of infection or tissue involvement.

### **Molluscipoxvirus**

molluscipoxvirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Molt**

A molt is shedding and replacement of an outer covering, such as the exoskeleton of an arthropod or the skin, feathers, or hair of an animal. The process is controlled by developmental and hormonal signals.

### **Mometasone**

Mometasone is a potent synthetic glucocorticoid used topically or by inhalation for inflammatory skin or airway disease. It reduces local inflammation but may cause skin atrophy, oral candidiasis, adrenal effects, or other corticosteroid adverse effects.

### **Mometasone Furoate**

Mometasone furoate is the furoate ester of the corticosteroid mometasone. Depending on formulation, it is used for inflammatory skin disease, allergic rhinitis, or asthma; local and systemic corticosteroid precautions apply.

### **Monascus**

monascus is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Monascus Ruber**

monascus ruber is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Monensin**

Monensin is a polyether ionophore antibiotic used mainly in veterinary and agricultural settings to alter rumen fermentation or prevent coccidiosis. It can be toxic to animals and humans, especially through effects on cardiac and skeletal muscle.

### **Mongolian Spot**

A Mongolian spot, now preferably called congenital dermal melanocytosis, is a flat blue-gray patch caused by melanocytes in the dermis, usually present at birth. It is benign and often fades during childhood but should be documented to distinguish it from bruising.



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### Monilethrix

Monilethrix is an inherited hair-shaft disorder in which hair has regularly spaced narrow segments and breaks easily, producing a beaded appearance. It commonly causes short, brittle scalp hair and may involve follicles elsewhere.

### Monitoring Device

A monitoring device measures and displays or records a physiologic variable, such as heart rhythm, oxygen saturation, blood pressure, glucose, temperature, or respiratory rate. Accuracy, calibration, and clinical context determine how results should be interpreted.

### Monkeypox

Monkeypox, now generally called mpox, is a zoonotic infection caused by monkeypox virus, an orthopoxvirus. It can cause fever, lymphadenopathy, and a characteristic rash or lesions and spreads through close contact, including skin-to-skin or respiratory contact.

### Monobactams

Monobactams are beta-lactam antibiotics containing a single beta-lactam ring, rather than the fused rings of penicillins or cephalosporins. Aztreonam is the principal clinical example and primarily targets aerobic gram-negative bacteria.

### Monoblast Count

A monoblast count is the number or proportion of monoblasts, immature precursors of monocytes, in a blood or bone-marrow sample. Increased blasts may support evaluation for acute myeloid leukemia or another marrow disorder and require expert morphologic or immunophenotypic interpretation.

### Monocrotophos

Monocrotophos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause acute cholinergic poisoning with secretions, bronchospasm, vomiting, bradycardia, weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

### Monogenic Obesity

Monogenic obesity is severe or early-onset obesity caused primarily by a pathogenic variant in a single gene involved in appetite, energy balance, or leptin-melanocortin signaling. Genetic evaluation may guide counseling and selected targeted treatment.

### Monograph

A monograph is a detailed, authoritative document devoted to one subject. In health care it may describe a drug's identity, quality, pharmacology, indications, dosing, safety, or regulatory standards.

### Monoiodotyrosine

Monoiodotyrosine is an iodinated tyrosine residue formed during thyroid-hormone synthesis. Coupling of iodinated tyrosine residues within thyroglobulin contributes to production of thyroxine and triiodothyronine.

### Monokines

Monokines are cytokines produced chiefly by monocytes and macrophages, including mediators such as tumor necrosis factor and interleukin-1. They regulate inflammation, immune responses, fever, and communication among cells.

### Monomer

A monomer is a relatively small molecule that can chemically bond with other monomers to form a polymer. Biological examples include amino acids and nucleotides; some industrial monomers can irritate tissues or be toxic.

### Monomethylhydrazine

Monomethylhydrazine is a volatile, corrosive, highly toxic chemical used as a rocket propellant. Exposure can injure the eyes, skin, lungs, liver, and nervous system and may cause seizures or systemic poisoning.

### Mononegavirales

mononegavirales is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause

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disease.

### **Mononeuropathy**

Mononeuropathy is dysfunction or injury of a single peripheral nerve. Common causes include compression, trauma, ischemia, inflammation, and metabolic disease; symptoms follow the nerve's distribution and may include pain, numbness, weakness, or autonomic changes.

### **Mononuclear Leukocyte**

A mononuclear leukocyte is a white blood cell with a single, non-lobed nucleus, chiefly a lymphocyte or monocyte. These cells participate in adaptive immunity, innate immune responses, antigen presentation, and inflammation.

### **Monoterpenes**

Monoterpenes are terpenoid compounds built from two isoprene units and containing 10 carbon atoms. They occur widely in plant essential oils and may have aromatic, biologic, or toxic effects depending on the compound and exposure.

### **Monozygotic Twin**

A monozygotic twin develops when one fertilized egg divides into two embryos. The twins share nearly identical nuclear genomes but can differ through developmental, epigenetic, mitochondrial, and environmental factors.

### **Montelukast**

Montelukast is a leukotriene CysLT<sub>1</sub>-receptor antagonist used for asthma prevention and allergic rhinitis; it is not a rescue bronchodilator, and neuropsychiatric adverse effects require attention.

### **Montelukast Sodium**

Montelukast sodium is the sodium salt of montelukast, a leukotriene-receptor antagonist used for asthma prevention and allergic rhinitis. It is not a rescue bronchodilator and carries an important warning for possible neuropsychiatric adverse effects.

### **Mood Swing**

A mood swing is a noticeable change in emotional state or affect over time. Occasional changes can be normal, while frequent, severe, or impairing swings may occur with mood disorders, substance use, medical illness, medications, or sleep disruption.

### **Mopidamol**

Mopidamol is a phosphodiesterase inhibitor that inhibits platelet aggregation. It was formerly investigated or used as an antineoplastic and is not a routine contemporary treatment in most clinical settings.

### **MOPP Protocol**

The MOPP protocol is a chemotherapy regimen consisting of mechlorethamine, vincristine (Oncovin), procarbazine, and prednisone. It was historically used for Hodgkin lymphoma and has largely been replaced by regimens with different efficacy and toxicity profiles.

### **Moral**

Moral refers to principles or judgments concerning right and wrong conduct. In health care, moral reasoning may inform ethical decisions but is distinct from clinical diagnosis and from legally enforceable rules.

### **Morale**

Morale is the confidence, motivation, and sense of shared purpose within a person or group. It can affect teamwork and occupational well-being but is not itself a specific medical diagnosis.

### **Moraxella**

*moraxella* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Atlantae**

*moraxella atlantae* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

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### **Moraxella Bovis**

*moraxella bovis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Canis**

*moraxella canis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Lacunata**

*moraxella lacunata* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Lincolnii**

*moraxella lincolnii* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Nonliquefaciens**

*moraxella nonliquefaciens* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Oblonga**

*moraxella oblonga* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxella Osloensis**

*moraxella osloensis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Moraxellaceae**

*moraxellaceae* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen

source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Morbillivirus**

*morbillivirus* is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Morcellation**

A biological or biochemical term involving morcellation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Morganella**

*morganella* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Morganella Morganii**

*morganella morganii* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Morning**

Morning is the early part of the day after waking or sunrise. In clinical descriptions, timing in the morning can help characterize symptoms, medication effects, hormone patterns, sleep disorders, or the timing of diagnostic measurements.

### **Morphinans**

Morphinans are a group of chemical compounds with a fused-ring structure related to morphine. The class includes opioid analgesics and other compounds with varying receptor activity, potency, and clinical effects.

### **Morphine**

Morphine is a potent opioid analgesic used for selected moderate-to-severe pain and palliative-care indications. It activates opioid receptors and can cause respiratory depression, sedation, constipation,

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nausea, tolerance, dependence, and overdose.

### **Morphine Sulfate**

Morphine sulfate is a salt formulation of the opioid analgesic morphine. It is available in immediate- and extended-release preparations for selected pain indications and carries risks of respiratory depression, misuse, dependence, and fatal overdose.

### **Morphogenesis**

morphogenesis is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Morpholino**

A morpholino is a synthetic antisense oligomer with a morpholine-ring backbone that binds complementary RNA sequences and alters splicing or translation. Morpholinos are used mainly in research and selected experimental applications.

### **Morphologic Response**

A morphologic response is a treatment-related change in the visible or microscopic structure of a lesion, tumor, tissue, or cell population. It may include shrinkage, necrosis, differentiation, or altered cellular features and is interpreted using disease-specific criteria.

### **Morula**

A morula is an early embryo consisting of a compact ball of blastomeres formed after several cleavage divisions. It develops into a blastocyst before implantation in the uterine lining.

### **Motexafin Gadolinium**

Motexafin gadolinium is an experimental texaphyrin compound designed to catalyze redox reactions and increase oxidative stress in tumor cells. It was investigated as a radiosensitizer and antineoplastic agent but is not a routine standard therapy.

### **Motexafin Lutetium**

Motexafin lutetium is an investigational texaphyrin

compound containing lutetium that can participate in redox chemistry and has been studied for photodynamic or other antineoplastic applications. It is not a routinely used approved treatment.

### **Motion Perception**

Motion perception is the ability of the visual, vestibular, and proprioceptive systems to detect and interpret movement of the body or surrounding objects. Disturbance may cause vertigo, oscillopsia, imbalance, or visual-motion sensitivity.

### **Motivation**

Motivation is the set of processes that initiate, direct, and sustain goal-directed behavior. Reduced or excessive motivation may occur with mood disorders, neurologic disease, substance use, medication effects, or other conditions.

### **Motor Aphasia**

Motor aphasia, often called expressive or Broca aphasia, is impaired ability to produce spoken or written language despite relatively preserved motivation to communicate. It commonly follows injury to dominant frontal language networks, especially from stroke.

### **Motor Delay**

Motor delay is slower-than-expected acquisition of gross- or fine-motor skills in a child. It may reflect neuromuscular, developmental, genetic, sensory, environmental, or systemic causes and warrants age-appropriate developmental assessment.

### **Motor Stereotypy**

A motor stereotypy is a repetitive, patterned, seemingly purposeless movement, such as hand flapping, rocking, or body waving. It may occur in typical development or with autism, intellectual disability, neurologic disease, or other conditions.

### **Motor Tic**

A motor tic is a sudden, brief, repetitive movement such as blinking, facial grimacing, or shoulder shrugging. Tics are often temporarily suppressible and may occur in transient tic disorder, persistent tic

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disorder, or Tourette syndrome.

### **Mouth Diseases**

A clinical condition or finding involving mouth diseases. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Mouth Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving mouth neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Movement**

Movement is a change in position of the body or a body part produced by coordinated activity of the nervous system, muscles, and joints. Abnormal movement may be excessive, reduced, involuntary, poorly coordinated, or restricted.

### **Movement Disorders**

A clinical condition or finding involving movement disorders. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Moxalactam**

Moxalactam is a beta-lactam antibiotic of the oxacephem group with activity against many gram-negative bacteria and some gram-positive organisms. It is rarely used today and may cause allergic reactions, diarrhea, or bleeding related to impaired coagulation.

### **Moxifloxacin**

Moxifloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; tendon injury, neuropathy, QT prolongation, dysglycaemia, and other class toxicities limit use.

### **Mrna Precursor**

A medical term referring to mrna precursor. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Mu-Chain Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving mu-chain

disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Mucinous**

Mucinous means containing, producing, or resembling mucin. In pathology, the term describes lesions or tumors with extracellular or intracellular mucin and must be interpreted with the organ, architecture, and other histologic features.

### **Mucinous Adenocarcinoma**

A neoplasm involving mucinous adenocarcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Mucinous Cystadenoma**

A mucinous cystadenoma is a usually benign cystic epithelial tumor that produces mucin, commonly arising in the ovary or pancreas. Large lesions may cause pain or pressure, and pathology is needed to distinguish benign from borderline or malignant mucinous tumors.

### **Mucoepidermoid Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving mucoepidermoid carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Mucolipidoses**

mucolipidoses is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis VII**

Mucopolysaccharidosis VII, or Sly syndrome, is a lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient beta-glucuronidase activity. Accumulation of glycosaminoglycans can cause skeletal, connective-tissue, visceral, developmental, and sometimes neurologic abnormalities.

### **Mucor**

mucor is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or

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superficial infection.

### **Mucor Ramosissimus**

mucor ramosissimus is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Mucorales**

mucorales is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Mucosal Immunity**

Mucosal immunity is immune defense at surfaces lining the respiratory, gastrointestinal, genitourinary, and other tracts. It includes epithelial barriers, mucus, secretory IgA, antimicrobial molecules, innate cells, and locally regulated adaptive responses.

### **Mucosal Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving mucosal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Mulibrey Nanism**

Mulibrey nanism is a rare inherited multisystem disorder, usually caused by biallelic variants in *TRIM37*. It may cause severe growth restriction, characteristic facial features, pericardial or hepatic disease, insulin resistance, and other organ involvement.

### **Muller Cells**

muller cells refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Multicenter Study**

A multicenter study is a clinical or research investigation conducted at two or more sites under a coordinated protocol. It can improve enrollment

and generalizability but requires harmonized methods, quality control, and site-specific oversight.

### **Multi-Drug Resistance**

Multidrug resistance is resistance of a microorganism, cancer, or other disease process to multiple drugs that would otherwise be active. Mechanisms include target changes, drug inactivation, reduced uptake, efflux, and altered repair or survival pathways.

### **Multienzyme Complexes**

A biological or biochemical term involving multienzyme complexes. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Multimodal Imaging**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to multimodal imaging. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Multinucleated Hepatocyte**

A multinucleated hepatocyte is a liver cell containing two or more nuclei, usually from nuclear division without complete cytokinesis. It may be a normal or reactive finding, but its significance depends on the number, morphology, and associated liver abnormalities.

### **Multiple Exostoses**

Multiple exostoses, or hereditary multiple osteochondromas, is an inherited disorder causing multiple cartilage-capped bony projections near growth plates. Lesions can deform bones, restrict motion, compress nerves or vessels, and rarely undergo malignant transformation.

### **Multiple Fibrofolliculomas**

Multiple fibrofolliculomas are benign hair-follicle tumors appearing as numerous small skin-colored papules, especially on the face and trunk. They are characteristic of Birt–Hogg–Dubé syndrome, which also carries risks of renal tumors and spontaneous pneumothorax.



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## Multiple Organ Failure

Multiple organ failure, also called multiple organ dysfunction syndrome, is progressive dysfunction of two or more organ systems, usually during severe critical illness. Causes include sepsis, shock, trauma, and major inflammation; treatment is supportive and directed at the underlying cause.

## Multiplicity

Multiplicity is the state of having more than one occurrence, copy, lesion, tumor, or pregnancy component. Its interpretation depends on context, such as multiple gestation, multifocal disease, or copy number in genetics.

## Multipolar Neuron

A multipolar neuron is a nerve cell with one axon and multiple dendrites. It is the most common neuronal form in the central nervous system and includes many motor neurons and interneurons.

## Multivesicular Body

A multivesicular body is an endosomal compartment containing many small intraluminal vesicles. It can fuse with the plasma membrane to release exosomes or with a lysosome to degrade its cargo.

## Muparfostat

Muparfostat (PI-88) is a mixture of highly sulfated, phosphorylated mannose oligosaccharides investigated as a heparanase inhibitor and antiangiogenic agent. It has been studied experimentally in cancer and is not a routine approved therapy.

## Mupirocin

Mupirocin is a topical antibiotic that inhibits bacterial isoleucyl-tRNA synthetase. It is used for selected skin infections and nasal eradication of certain staphylococci; resistance can develop with inappropriate or prolonged use.

## Muramidase

Muramidase, or lysozyme, is an enzyme that cleaves the peptidoglycan backbone of bacterial cell walls. It is present in secretions and innate immune cells and contributes to defense against susceptible bacteria.

## Muscarinic Antagonist

A muscarinic antagonist blocks acetylcholine at muscarinic receptors in smooth muscle, glands, the heart, and the central nervous system. Examples include atropine, ipratropium, and oxybutynin; effects can include dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, tachycardia, and confusion.

## Muscidae

Muscidae is a family of flies that includes the housefly. Some species can mechanically carry pathogens to food or wounds, and their larvae may occasionally cause myiasis.

## Muscimol

Muscimol is a psychoactive compound found in some *Amanita* mushrooms and an agonist at GABA-A receptors. Ingestion can cause altered perception, sedation, agitation, incoordination, or seizures and may require toxicologic evaluation.

## Muscle Cell

muscle cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## Muscle Cramp

A muscle cramp is a sudden, involuntary, painful contraction of a muscle. It may follow exertion, dehydration, electrolyte disturbance, pregnancy, medication use, nerve disease, or vascular disease; recurrent cramps need assessment of the cause.

### Synonyms:

Cramp, Muscle

## Muscle Development

Muscle development is the formation, growth, differentiation, and maturation of muscle tissue. It depends on genetic programs, neural input, hormones, nutrition, mechanical loading, and repair processes.

## Muscle Fiber

A muscle fiber is an individual muscle cell containing

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contractile myofibrils. Skeletal muscle fibers vary in size and metabolic properties, while cardiac and smooth muscle cells have distinct structures and functions.

### **Muscle Hypertrophy**

Muscle hypertrophy is enlargement of individual muscle fibers, usually in response to resistance, hormonal stimulation, or compensatory workload. It can be physiologic or associated with disease, depending on the muscle and cause.

### **Muscle Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving muscle neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Muscle Protein**

muscle protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Muscle Relaxant**

A muscle relaxant is a medicine that reduces skeletal-muscle spasm or contraction. Centrally acting agents reduce muscle spasm through the nervous system, whereas neuromuscular blockers interrupt transmission at the neuromuscular junction and require respiratory support.

### **Muscle Rigidity**

Muscle rigidity is abnormal resistance to passive movement caused by sustained muscle contraction or altered tone. It occurs in conditions such as Parkinson disease, dystonia, meningitis, neuroleptic malignant syndrome, and tetanus.

### **Muscle Spindle**

A muscle spindle is a sensory receptor within skeletal muscle that detects muscle length and the rate of length change. Its afferent signals contribute to the stretch reflex, muscle tone, posture, and coordinated movement.

### **Muscle Strength**

Muscle strength is the maximal force a muscle or muscle group can generate under specified conditions. It is assessed by functional or resisted testing and may be reduced by muscle, nerve, neuromuscular-junction, central, or systemic disorders.

### **Muscle Tonus**

Muscle tonus, or muscle tone, is the continuous, low-level activity and resistance to passive stretch present in resting muscle. It depends on spinal and supraspinal reflexes and may be abnormally increased or decreased in neurologic disease.

### **Musculoskeletal Deformity**

A musculoskeletal deformity is an abnormal shape, alignment, or structure of bone, joint, muscle, or related tissue. It may be congenital, developmental, traumatic, degenerative, neuromuscular, or caused by disease.

### **Musculoskeletal Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving musculoskeletal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Musculoskeletal Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving musculoskeletal injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Musculoskeletal System**

The musculoskeletal system consists of bones, joints, cartilage, ligaments, tendons, muscles, and associated connective tissues. It provides support, protects organs, enables movement, and contributes to mineral storage and blood-cell production.

### **Mustard Compounds**

Mustard compounds are chemical agents containing reactive sulfur or nitrogen mustard groups that can alkylate DNA and other molecules. Some are chemotherapy drugs; others are highly toxic chemical-warfare agents.

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## Mustard Gas

Mustard gas, or sulfur mustard, is a vesicant chemical-warfare agent that damages skin, eyes, and respiratory tissues and can cause blistering, airway injury, and delayed complications. It is not a true gas at ordinary temperatures and has no specific widely available antidote.

## Mutagenicity Test

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to mutagenicity test. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

## Mutant

A mutant is a cell, organism, or genetic sequence carrying a mutation relative to a reference or parental form. The change may have no effect, alter a trait, or cause disease, depending on its location and functional consequence.

## Mutant Proteins

mutant proteins is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## Mutate

To mutate means to undergo a change in genetic sequence. Mutations arise spontaneously or from replication errors, DNA damage, or mutagen exposure and may be inherited, acquired in somatic cells, harmful, neutral, or beneficial.

## Mutation Abnormality

A mutation abnormality is an atypical change in DNA sequence or chromosome structure identified relative to a reference. Its clinical significance must be classified using evidence, such as pathogenic, likely pathogenic, uncertain significance, likely benign, or benign.

## Mycelium

A mycelium is the network of branching hyphae that forms the vegetative body of a fungus. It grows through soil, tissue, or other substrates and pro-

duces or supports formation of reproductive structures.

## Mycobacteriaceae

mycobacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mycobacterium Avium

mycobacterium avium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mycobacterium Bovis

mycobacterium bovis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mycobacterium Chelonae

mycobacterium chelonae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mycobacterium Flavescens

mycobacterium flavescens is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Mycobacterium Fortuitum

mycobacterium fortuitum is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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### **Mycobacterium Gordonae**

mycobacterium gordonae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Haemophilum**

mycobacterium haemophilum is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Infection**

mycobacterium infection is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Kansalii**

mycobacterium kansasii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Scrofulaceum**

mycobacterium scrofulaceum is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Smegmatis**

mycobacterium smegmatis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Szulgai**

mycobacterium szulgai is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on

pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Terrae**

mycobacterium terrae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobacterium Ulcerans**

mycobacterium ulcerans is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Mycobiome**

The mycobiome is the community of fungi living in a particular environment or body site, including the human microbiome. Its composition can be influenced by immunity, antibiotics, diet, and disease, and detection does not by itself prove infection.

### **Mycophenolate Mofetil**

Mycophenolate mofetil is a prodrug of mycophenolic acid that inhibits inosine monophosphate dehydrogenase and lymphocyte proliferation. It is used as an immunosuppressant, especially after organ transplantation, and can cause infection, cytopenias, gastrointestinal effects, and serious fetal harm.

### **Mycophenolic Acid**

mycophenolic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Mycoplasma Hominis**

mycoplasma hominis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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## **Mycoplasma Orale**

mycoplasma orale is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Mycoplasma Pneumoniae**

mycoplasma pneumoniae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Mycoplasmal Pneumonia**

mycoplasmal pneumonia is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Mycoplasmataceae**

mycoplasmataceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## **Mycosis Fungoides Lymphoma**

A neoplasm involving mycosis fungoides lymphoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## **Mydriatics**

Mydriatics are medicines that dilate the pupil, usually by stimulating the iris dilator muscle or blocking muscarinic receptors in the iris sphincter. They are used for eye examination and selected procedures and can precipitate angle-closure glaucoma in susceptible eyes.

## **Myelination**

Myelination is formation of a myelin sheath around an axon by oligodendrocytes in the central nervous system or Schwann cells in the peripheral nervous system. It increases the speed and efficiency of nerve

conduction.

## **Myelitis**

Myelitis is inflammation of the spinal cord or, less commonly, other neural tissue described by the term. Transverse myelitis can cause weakness, sensory changes, and bladder or bowel dysfunction and requires urgent evaluation for infectious, immune, vascular, or compressive causes.

## **Myeloablative Agonist**

A myeloablative agent, likely intended by this term, is a treatment that severely or completely destroys bone-marrow blood-forming cells. It is used before selected stem-cell transplants and requires stem-cell rescue because of profound, prolonged cytopenias.

## **Myeloablative Chemotherapy**

myeloablative chemotherapy is used in relation to myeloablative chemotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Myeloid Cell**

myeloid cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## **Myeloid Leukemia**

A neoplasm involving myeloid leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## **Myeloid Sarcoma**

A neoplasm involving myeloid sarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## **Myelolipoma**

A medical term referring to myelolipoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Myelomonocyte**

A medical term referring to myelomonocyte. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it

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is used.

### **Myelopoiesis**

A medical term referring to myelopoiesis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myeloproliferative Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving myeloproliferative neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Myelosuppressive Therapy**

myelosuppressive therapy is used in relation to myelosuppressive therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Myenteric Plexus**

A medical term referring to myenteric plexus. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myhre Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving myhre syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Myocardial Bridging**

Myocardial bridging occurs when a segment of a coronary artery tunnels through heart muscle and may be compressed during contraction.

### **Myocardial Contusion**

A biological or biochemical term involving myocardial contusion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Myocardial Reperfusion**

A biological or biochemical term involving myocardial reperfusion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Myoclonic Epilepsy**

A medical term referring to myoclonic epilepsy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myoepithelial Cell**

myoepithelial cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Myoepithelioma**

A myoepithelioma is a tumor composed of myoepithelial cells and can be benign or malignant, commonly arising in salivary or other glands.

### **Myofibril**

A medical term referring to myofibril. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myofibrillar Myopathy**

Myofibrillar myopathy is a group of inherited muscle disorders with abnormal protein aggregates and progressive skeletal-muscle weakness, sometimes involving heart or breathing muscles.

### **Myofibroblasts**

A medical term referring to myofibroblasts. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myofibromatosis**

Myofibromatosis is a benign proliferation of myofibroblastic tumors, often in infants or children and involving skin, muscle, bone, or internal organs.

### **Myofilament**

A medical term referring to myofilament. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myogenesis**

myogenesis is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Myogenin**

A medical term referring to myogenin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### Myokymia

A medical term referring to myokymia. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Myopericytoma

A myopericytoma is a usually benign perivascular tumor composed of cells around small blood vessels, often occurring in skin or soft tissue.

### Myosin Atpase

A medical term referring to myosin atpase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Myositis Ossifican

A medical term referring to myositis ossifican. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Myotonic Disorder

A clinical condition or finding involving myotonic disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Myristic Acid

A biological or biochemical term involving myristic acid. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Myroides

A biomedical term referring to myroides; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Myroides Odoratus

A biomedical term referring to myroides odoratus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Myxococcales

A biomedical term referring to myxococcales; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Myxococcus

myxococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Myxofibroma

A myxofibroma is a benign tumor containing fibrous and gelatinous myxoid tissue, often arising in the jaw or other connective tissue.

### Myxoid Cyst

A myxoid cyst is a gelatinous fluid-filled lesion near a joint or tendon, commonly on a finger near the distal joint and nail.

### Myxomycete

A medical term referring to myxomycete. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Myxopapillary Ependymoma

Myxopapillary ependymoma is a usually slow-growing spinal tumor arising from ependymal cells, commonly in the conus or filum terminale.

### Myxosarcoma

A neoplasm involving myxosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

#### Synonyms:

It may cause vaginal bleeding, cramping, and an open cervix and requires clinical assessment. Incomplete abortion; incomplete pregnancy loss.

### Muscle Pain

Pain, soreness, or aching in one or more muscles caused by exertion, injury, infection, inflammation, medicines, or an underlying medical condition.

### Macular Degeneration, Dry

Alternate index label; see *Dry macular degeneration*.

### Macular Degeneration, Wet

Alternate index label; see *Wet macular degeneration*.

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### **Mad Cow Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease*.

### **Malignant Fibrous Histiocytoma**

Alternate index label; see *Undifferentiated pleomorphic sarcoma*.

### **Mallet Toe And Hammertoe**

Alternate index label; see *Hammertoe and mallet toe*.

### **MALS**

Alternate index label; see *Median arcuate ligament syndrome (MALS)*.

### **MALT Lymphoma**

Alternate index label; see *Extranodal marginal zone lymphoma of mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue (MALT)*.

### **Manic-Depressive Illness**

Alternate index label; see *Bipolar disorder*.

### **MASH**

Alternate index label; see *Fatty liver disease (MASLD)*.

### **MASLD**

Alternate index label; see *Fatty liver disease (MASLD)*.

### **MCRPC**

Alternate index label; see *Metastatic castration-resistant prostate cancer (mCRPC)*.

### **MD**

Alternate index label; see *Muscular dystrophy*.

### **MDS**

Alternate index label; see *Myelodysplastic syndromes*.

### **ME/CFS**

Alternate index label; see *Myalgic encephalomyeli-*

*tis/chronic fatigue syndrome (ME/CFS)*.

### **Measles, German**

Alternate index label; see *Rubella*.

### **Medial Epicondylitis**

Alternate index label; see *Golfer's elbow (Medial epicondylitis)*.

### **Medial Tibial Stress Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Shin splints*.

### **Mediterranean Anemia**

Alternate index label; see *Thalassemia*.

### **Melanoma Of The Eye**

Melanoma of the eye concerns melanoma of the eye, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **MEN 2**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple endocrine neoplasia, type 2 (MEN 2)*.

### **Meniscus Tear**

Alternate index label; see *Torn meniscus*.

### **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis**

Alternate index label; see *Fatty liver disease (MASLD)*.

### **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Fatty liver disease (MASLD)*.

### **Metastatic Colorectal Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Stage 4 (metastatic) colon cancer*.

### **Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus**

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## **Aureus Infection**

Alternate index label; see *MRSA infection*.

## **MF**

Alternate index label; see *Mycosis fungoides*.

## **MFS**

Alternate index label; see *Myxofibrosarcoma*.

## **MG**

Alternate index label; see *Myasthenia gravis*.

## **MGUS**

Alternate index label; see *Monoclonal gammopathy of undetermined significance (MGUS)*.

## **Microscopic Hematuria**

Alternate index label; see *Blood in urine (hematuria)*.

## **Milk Intolerance**

Alternate index label; see *Lactose intolerance*.

## **MISME**

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

## **Mono**

Alternate index label; see *Mononucleosis*.

## **MOG Antibody-Associated Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *Myelin oligodendrocyte glycoprotein antibody-associated disease (MOGAD)*.

## **MOGAD**

Alternate index label; see *Myelin oligodendrocyte glycoprotein antibody-associated disease (MOGAD)*.

## **Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Kawasaki disease*.

## **Mucosa-Assisted Lymphoid Tissue Lymphoma**

Alternate index label; see *Extranodal marginal zone*

*lymphoma of mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue (MALT)*.

## **Multiple Inherited Schwannomas, Meningiomas, And Ependymomas**

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

## **Munchausen Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Factitious disorder*.

## **Myelodysplastic Neoplasms**

Alternate index label; see *Myelodysplastic syndromes*.

## **MZL**

Alternate index label; see *Marginal zone lymphoma*.

## **Macroamylasemia**

Macroamylasemia is a benign condition in which amylase binds to immunoglobulin and remains in blood, causing high serum amylase with low urinary clearance.

## **Magnesium Blood Test**

Magnesium blood test examines magnesium blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Magnesium In Diet**

Magnesium in diet addresses care related to magnesium in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Major Depression With Psychotic Features**

A biological or biochemical term involving major depression with psychotic features. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## **Make Peak Flow A Habit**

Make peak flow a habit is a defined medical, bio-

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logical, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Make The Most Of Your Doctor Visit**

Make the most of your doctor visit examines make the most of your doctor visit; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Make Time To Move**

A medical term referring to make time to move. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Making Everyday Tasks Easier When You Have Arthritis**

Arthritis-friendly task strategies include pacing, joint protection, adaptive tools, ergonomic positioning, heat or exercise as appropriate, and occupational-therapy guidance.

### **Malathion Poisoning**

Malathion poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to malathion poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Male Pattern Baldness**

A medical term referring to male pattern baldness. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Malignant Otitis Externa**

Malignant otitis externa is an invasive infection of the external ear canal and skull base, usually in older adults with diabetes or immune suppression, requiring urgent treatment.

### **Malignant Teratoma Of The Mediastinum**

A malignant mediastinal teratoma is a cancerous germ-cell tumor in the central chest that may compress nearby organs and requires specialist staging and treatment.

### **Mallet Finger - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mallet finger - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Malocclusion Of Teeth**

A biological or biochemical term involving malocclusion of teeth. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Mammogram - Calcifications**

Mammogram - calcifications examines mammogram - calcifications; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Managing Latex Allergies At Home**

Managing latex allergies at home addresses care related to managing latex allergies at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Managing Menopause At Home**

Managing menopause at home addresses care related to managing menopause at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Managing Migraines At Home**

Managing migraines at home addresses care related to managing migraines at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Managing Pain During Labor**

A clinical condition involving managing Pain During Labor; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Managing Tension Headaches At Home**

Managing tension headaches at home addresses care related to managing tension headaches at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

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## Managing Your Blood Sugar

Blood-sugar management combines appropriate food, activity, monitoring, medicines, sick-day planning, and recognition of low or high glucose according to an individualized care plan.

## Managing Your Chronic Back Pain

A clinical condition involving managing Your Chronic Back Pain; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Managing Your Depression - Teens

A biological or biochemical term involving managing your depression - teens. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Managing Your Weight Gain During Pregnancy

Managing your weight gain during pregnancy addresses care related to managing your weight gain during pregnancy, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Managing Your Weight With Healthy Eating

Managing your weight with healthy eating addresses care related to managing your weight with healthy eating, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Marijuana Intoxication

Marijuana intoxication involves toxic or environmental exposure to marijuana intoxication; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Marine Animal Stings Or Bites

A medical term referring to marine animal stings or bites. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Mastectomy - Discharge

Mastectomy - discharge examines mastectomy - dis-

charge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Mastectomy And Breast Reconstruction - What To Ask Your Doctor

Mastectomy and breast reconstruction - what to ask your doctor examines mastectomy and breast reconstruction - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Mathematics Disorder

A clinical condition involving mathematics Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Maximizing Your Teaching Moment

A medical term referring to maximizing your teaching moment. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Meatal Stenosis

Meatal stenosis is narrowing of the external urethral opening, causing a thin or deviated urinary stream, straining, pain, or spraying.

## Mechanical Ventilator - Infants

A medical term referring to mechanical ventilator - infants. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Meckel Diverticulectomy

Meckel diverticulectomy examines meckel diverticulectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Meclofenamate Overdose

Meclofenamate overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to meclufenamate overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

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## **Medial Epicondylitis - Golfer's Elbow**

Medial epicondylitis is overuse-related tendon degeneration and pain at the inner elbow where forearm flexor tendons attach.

## **Mediastinal Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving mediastinal Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Mediastinoscopy With Biopsy**

Mediastinoscopy with biopsy examines mediastinoscopy with biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Medical Marijuana**

Medical marijuana involves toxic or environmental exposure to medical marijuana; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Medicine Safety - Filling Your Prescription**

Medicine safety - Filling your prescription addresses care related to medicine safety - filling your prescription, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicine Safety And Children**

Medicine safety and children addresses care related to medicine safety and children, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicine Safety During Your Hospital Stay**

Medicine safety during your hospital stay addresses care related to medicine safety during your hospital stay, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicines For ADHD**

Medicines for ADHD addresses care related to medicines for adhd, including practical measures,

warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicines For Back Pain**

Medicines for back pain addresses care related to medicines for back pain, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicines For Osteoporosis**

Medicines for osteoporosis addresses care related to medicines for osteoporosis, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicines For Sleep**

Medicines for sleep addresses care related to medicines for sleep, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Medicines, Injections, And Supplements For Arthritis**

Medicines, injections, and supplements for arthritis examines medicines, injections, and supplements for arthritis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Meibomianitis**

Meibomianitis is inflammation or blockage of oil-producing eyelid glands, causing irritated eyelid margins, dry eye, crusting, or recurrent styes.

## **Meniere Disease - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to meniere disease - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Meningitis - Cryptococcal**

Cryptococcal meningitis is fungal infection and inflammation of the brain coverings, occurring mainly with advanced immune suppression and requiring prolonged antifungal treatment.



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### **Meningitis - Tuberculous**

Tuberculous meningitis is slow infection and inflammation of the meninges caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis and can cause stroke, hydrocephalus, or neurologic injury.

### **Meningocele Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to meningocele repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Meningococcal ACWY Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to meningococcal acwy vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Meningococcal B Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to meningococcal b vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Meningococcal Meningitis**

Meningococcal meningitis is bacterial infection of the meninges caused by Neisseria meningitidis and can progress rapidly to sepsis, shock, or death.

### **Meningococcemia**

Meningococcemia is bloodstream infection with Neisseria meningitidis, causing fever, rash, shock, clotting failure, and potentially fatal sepsis.

### **Meniscal Allograft Transplantation**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to meniscal allograft transplantation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Meniscus Tears - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to meniscus tears - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Mental Status Testing**

Mental status testing examines mental status testing; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Menthol Poisoning**

Menthol poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to menthol poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Meperidine Hydrochloride Overdose**

Meperidine hydrochloride overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to meperidine hydrochloride overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Meprobamate Overdose**

Meprobamate overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to meprobamate overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Merbromin Poisoning**

Merbromin poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to merbromin poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mercuric Chloride Poisoning**

Mercuric chloride poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to mercuric chloride poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mercuric Oxide Poisoning**

Mercuric oxide poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to mercuric oxide poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Merthiolate Poisoning**

Merthiolate poisoning involves toxic or environmen-

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tal exposure to merthiolate poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mesenteric Angiography**

Mesenteric angiography examines mesenteric angiography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Mesenteric Venous Thrombosis**

Mesenteric venous thrombosis is a clot in veins draining the intestine, causing abdominal pain, bowel swelling, ischemia, or infarction.

### **Metabolic Neuropathies**

Metabolic neuropathies concerns metabolic neuropathies, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Metal Cleaner Poisoning**

Metal cleaner poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to metal cleaner poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Metal Polish Poisoning**

Metal polish poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to metal polish poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Metastatic Brain Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving metastatic Brain Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Metastatic Pleural Tumor**

A biomedical term referring to metastatic pleural tumor; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Metatarsal Fracture (Acute) - Aftercare**

Metatarsal fracture (acute) - aftercare examines metatarsal fracture (acute) - aftercare; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Metatarsal Stress Fractures - Aftercare**

Metatarsal stress fractures - aftercare examines metatarsal stress fractures - aftercare; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Metatarsus Adductus**

Metatarsus adductus examines metatarsus adductus; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Methadone Overdose**

Methadone overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to methadone overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methamphetamine Overdose**

Methamphetamine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to methamphetamine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methanol Test**

Methanol test involves toxic or environmental exposure to methanol test; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methemoglobinemia - Acquired**

Acquired methemoglobinemia follows exposure to oxidizing medicines or chemicals, leaving hemoglobin unable to release oxygen and causing cyanosis or hypoxia.

### **Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus Aureus (MRSA)**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called

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methicillin-resistant staphylococcus aureus (mrsa). Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Methyl Salicylate Overdose**

Methyl salicylate overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to methyl salicylate overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methylene Blue Test**

Methylene blue test involves toxic or environmental exposure to methylene blue test; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methylmalonic Acid Blood Test**

Methylmalonic acid blood test involves toxic or environmental exposure to methylmalonic acid blood test; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methylmalonic Acidemia**

Methylmalonic acidemia involves toxic or environmental exposure to methylmalonic acidemia; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Methylmercury Poisoning**

Methylmercury poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to methylmercury poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Metopic Ridge**

A metopic ridge is a palpable or visible line along the forehead from fusion of the metopic suture; it may be normal or associated with trigonocephaly.

### **MIBG Scintiscan**

MIBG scintiscan examines mibg scintiscan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Microalbuminuria Test**

Microalbuminuria test examines microalbuminuria test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS)**

A clinical condition involving middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Midline Venous Catheters - Infants**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving midline venous catheters - infants. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Migraine - Resources**

Migraine - resources addresses care related to migraine - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Mild To Moderate COVID-19 - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mild to moderate covid-19 - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Mildew Remover Poisoning**

Mildew remover poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to mildew remover poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Millipede Toxin**

Millipede toxin involves toxic or environmental exposure to millipede toxin; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mineral Oil Overdose**

Mineral oil overdose involves toxic or environmental

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exposure to mineral oil overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mineral Spirits Poisoning**

Mineral spirits poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to mineral spirits poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Minimally Invasive Hip Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to minimally invasive hip replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Minor Burns - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to minor burns - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Miscarriage - Threatened**

A medical term referring to miscarriage - threatened. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Mistletoe Poisoning**

Mistletoe poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to mistletoe poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mitral Valve Regurgitation**

A biological or biochemical term involving mitral valve regurgitation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

#### **Synonyms:**

Regurgitation, Mitral Valve

### **Mitral Valve Surgery - Minimally Invasive**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mitral valve surgery - minimally invasive; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up

depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Mitral Valve Surgery - Open**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mitral valve surgery - open; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **MMR (Measles, Mumps, And Rubella) Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to mmr (measles, mumps, and rubella) vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **MMRV (Measles, Mumps, Rubella, And Varicella) Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

MMRV (measles, mumps, rubella, and varicella) vaccine - what you need to know refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Mohs Micrographic Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mohs micrographic surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Monitoring Your Baby Before Labor**

Monitoring your baby before labor examines monitoring your baby before labor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Mononucleosis Spot Test**

Mononucleosis spot test examines mononucleosis spot test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Morphine Overdose**

Morphine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to morphine overdose; dose, route, tim-

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ing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Mouth And Neck Radiation - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to mouth and neck radiation - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Mouth Sores**

Mouth sores are painful ulcers, blisters, erosions, or inflamed areas caused by trauma, infection, immune disease, medicines, nutritional deficiency, or cancer.

### **Mouthwash Overdose**

Mouthwash overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to mouthwash overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Movement - Uncontrollable**

A medical term referring to movement - uncontrollable. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Movement - Uncontrolled Or Slow**

A medical term referring to movement - uncontrolled or slow. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Movement - Uncoordinated**

A medical term referring to movement - uncoordinated. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Movement - Unpredictable Or Jerky**

Movement - unpredictable or jerky examines movement - unpredictable or jerky; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Moving A Patient From Bed To A Wheelchair**

Safe bed-to-wheelchair transfer uses assessment, locked equipment, appropriate assistance or aids,

clear communication, and protection from falls and skin injury.

### **MRI And Low Back Pain**

MRI and low back pain examines mri and low back pain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **MSG Symptom Complex**

A medical term referring to msg symptom complex. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Mucopolysaccharides**

Mucopolysaccharides, or glycosaminoglycans, are long sugar chains in connective-tissue matrix; abnormal breakdown causes mucopolysaccharidosis storage disorders.

### **Mucopolysaccharidoses**

Mucopolysaccharidoses are inherited lysosomal storage diseases in which glycosaminoglycans accumulate, causing variable skeletal, organ, airway, neurologic, and developmental problems.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I**

Mucopolysaccharidosis type I is an inherited alpha-L-iduronidase deficiency ranging from severe Hurler syndrome to milder forms, with skeletal, airway, cardiac, eye, and neurologic disease.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis Type II**

Mucopolysaccharidosis type II, or Hunter syndrome, is an X-linked iduronate-2-sulfatase deficiency causing accumulation of glycosaminoglycans and multi-system disease.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis Type III**

Mucopolysaccharidosis type III, or Sanfilippo syndrome, is an inherited disorder of heparan-sulfate breakdown causing progressive neurodevelopmental and behavioral decline.

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### **Mucopolysaccharidosis Type IV**

Mucopolysaccharidosis type IV, or Morquio syndrome, is an inherited disorder of keratan-sulfate breakdown causing skeletal and connective-tissue abnormalities with variable neurologic involvement.

### **Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN) I**

MEN type 1 is an inherited tumor syndrome involving parathyroid, pituitary, and pancreatic or duodenal neuroendocrine tumors, often caused by MEN1 variants.

### **Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN) II**

MEN type 2 is an inherited syndrome with medullary thyroid cancer, pheochromocytoma, and sometimes parathyroid disease, commonly involving RET variants.

### **Multiple Mononeuropathy**

Multiple mononeuropathy is patchy dysfunction of separate individual nerves, often caused by vasculitis, diabetes, infection, inflammation, or infiltrative disease.

### **Multiple Sclerosis - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to multiple sclerosis - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Multiple Sclerosis - Resources**

Multiple sclerosis - resources addresses care related to multiple sclerosis - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Multiple System Atrophy - Cerebellar Subtype**

The cerebellar subtype of multiple-system atrophy is a progressive neurodegenerative disorder causing ataxia, coordination problems, autonomic dysfunction, and sometimes parkinsonism.

### **Multiple System Atrophy - Parkinsonian**

### **Type**

The parkinsonian subtype of multiple-system atrophy causes poorly levodopa-responsive rigidity and slowed movement together with autonomic failure and possible cerebellar signs.

### **Multiple Vitamin Overdose**

Multiple vitamin overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to multiple vitamin overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Munchausen Syndrome By Proxy**

A clinical condition involving munchausen Syndrome By Proxy; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

#### **Synonyms:**

MSBP (Munchausen Syndrome By Proxy)

### **Muscle Aches**

Muscle aches refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Muscle Biopsy**

Muscle biopsy examines muscle biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Muscle Cramps**

Muscle cramps refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Muscle Disorder**

A biomedical term referring to muscle disorder; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Muscle Function Loss**

Muscle function loss examines muscle function loss; interpretation depends on the specimen or body



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region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Muscle Strain Treatment**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to muscle strain treatment; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Muscle Twitching**

A biomedical term referring to muscle twitching; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Muscular Dystrophy - Resources**

Muscular dystrophy - resources addresses care related to muscular dystrophy - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome (ME/CFS)**

A clinical condition involving myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome (ME/CFS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

#### **Synonyms:**

ME/CFS SEID Systemic Exertional Intolerance Disease

### **Myasthenia Gravis - Resources**

Myasthenia gravis - resources addresses care related to myasthenia gravis - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Mycobacterial Culture**

Mycobacterial culture examines mycobacterial culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Myocardial Biopsy**

Myocardial biopsy examines myocardial biopsy; in-

terpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Myocarditis - Pediatric**

Pediatric myocarditis is inflammation of the heart muscle, often after infection or immune injury, causing chest symptoms, arrhythmia, heart failure, or shock.

### **Myoglobin Blood Test**

Myoglobin blood test examines myoglobin blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Myoglobin Urine Test**

Myoglobin urine test examines myoglobin urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Myristica Oil Poisoning**

Myristica oil poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to myristica oil poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Myths About Drinking Alcohol**

Common alcohol myths can understate risks: no beverage makes heavy drinking safe, and effects depend on dose, pattern, health, medicines, pregnancy, and individual vulnerability.

### **Malaria Contagious (Is Malaria Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Malaria Contagious.

### **Malaria Facts**

Malaria is a mosquito-borne infection caused by Plasmodium parasites and can produce fever, chills, anemia, confusion, kidney injury, or death. Travel history and testing are crucial because prompt species-specific antimalarial treatment is lifesaving.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Plasmodium Infection (Malaria Facts)

### **Malignant Melanoma (Melanoma)**

Alternate index label for Melanoma.

### **Malt Soup Extract**

Malt extract is a concentrated food ingredient made from germinated grain and contains sugars and other grain components. Its nutritional value and suitability depend on portion, ingredients, gluten content, diabetes management, and the reason it is being used.

### **Man Boobs (Gynecomastia)**

Alternate index label for Gynecomastia.

### **Mania Vs Hypomania**

Mania is a sustained elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy and marked impairment, possible psychosis, or need for hospitalization. Hypomania is milder, lasts at least several days, and causes observable change without severe functional impairment or psychosis.

### **Mantle Cell Lymphoma (MCL)**

Alternate index label for MCL.

### **Marburg Virus History, Symptoms, And Treatment**

Marburg virus disease is a severe filovirus infection spread through contact with infected body fluids and contaminated materials. Fever, weakness, gastrointestinal symptoms, rash, bleeding, and shock may occur; isolation, supportive critical care, and public-health response are essential.

### **MC Lymphoma (Mantle Cell Lymphoma (MCL))**

Alternate index label for Mantle Cell Lymphoma (MCL).

### **MCL Injury (Medial Collateral Ligament (MCL) Injury)**

Alternate index label for Medial Collateral Ligament (MCL) Injury.

### **Measles (Rubeola)**

Alternate index label for Rubeola.

### **Medial Collateral Ligament (MCL) Injury**

Alternate index label for MCL) Injur.

### **Median Nerve Compression (Carpal Tunnel Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Carpal Tunnel Syndrome.

### **Medical Marijuana (Medical Cannabis)**

Alternate index label for Medical Cannabis.

### **Medical Marijuana (Medical Marijuana (Medical Cannabis))**

Alternate index label for Medical Marijuana (Medical Cannabis).

### **Medications Type 2 Diabetes (Antidiabetics-Oral)**

Alternate index label for antidiabetics-oral.

### **Mediterranean Fever (Brucellosis Facts)**

Alternate index label for Brucellosis Facts.

### **Melanoma (Skin Cancer Overview)**

Alternate index label for Skin Cancer Overview.

### **Melanositis Coli**

Melanositis coli is dark pigmentation of the colon lining caused by lipofuscin accumulation, classically associated with prolonged stimulant-laxative use. It is usually benign and may fade after stopping the trigger, but the underlying constipation and medication use should be reviewed.

### **Men Disease Prevention (Disease Prevention In Men)**

Alternate index label for Disease Prevention in Men.

### **Men Health Screening For Men (Disease Prevention In Men)**

Alternate index label for Disease Prevention in Men.

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### **Men Night Sweats (Night Sweats)**

Alternate index label for Night Sweats.

### **Menieres Disease (Meniere Disease)**

Alternate index label for Meniere Disease.

### **MeningitContagious (Is Meningitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Meningitis Contagious.

### **Meningoencephalitis Toxoplasma (Toxoplasmosis)**

Alternate index label for Toxoplasmosis.

### **Menopause Hot Flashes (Hot Flashes)**

Alternate index label for Hot Flashes.

### **Menstrual Cramps And PMS Medication Guide**

Menstrual cramps arise from uterine prostaglandins, while premenstrual syndrome causes cyclical physical and emotional symptoms before menstruation. Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, hormonal methods, lifestyle measures, or other treatments are selected according to symptoms and contraindications.

#### **Synonyms:**

Premenstrual Syndrome (Menstrual Cramps And PMS Medication Guide)

### **Mental Health (Psychology)**

Alternate index label for Psychology.

### **Mental Illness In Children**

Mental illness in children may appear as persistent changes in mood, behavior, learning, sleep, appetite, relationships, or development. Evaluation considers age, medical causes, trauma, school context, family history, safety, and the child's strengths and supports.

### **MERS (Middle East Respiratory Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Middle East Respiratory Syndrome.

### **Middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS (Middle East Respiratory Syndrome))**

Alternate index label for MERS (Middle East Respiratory Syndrome).

### **Midwife Vs. Doula (Doula Vs. Midwife)**

Alternate index label for Doula vs. Midwife.

### **Migraine And Seizures Symptoms And Signs**

Migraine can cause recurrent headache with nausea, light sensitivity, or aura, while seizures result from abnormal electrical brain activity and may cause altered awareness, movements, sensations, or post-event confusion. Overlap exists, so history and neurologic evaluation are important.

### **Migraine And Stroke Symptoms**

Migraine aura usually develops gradually and resolves, whereas stroke symptoms often begin suddenly and cause persistent focal deficits such as weakness, speech trouble, facial droop, or vision loss. New or atypical neurologic symptoms require emergency stroke assessment.

### **Migraine Vs Headache Whats The Difference**

A headache is a symptom with many causes; migraine is a neurologic disorder with recurrent attacks often involving throbbing pain, nausea, light or sound sensitivity, and sometimes aura. Diagnosis depends on pattern, associated symptoms, and examination.

### **Milk Intolerance (Lactose Intolerance)**

Alternate index label for Lactose Intolerance.

### **Mini Stroke (Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA, Mini-Stroke))**

Alternate index label for Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA, Mini-Stroke).

### **Mini-Stroke Vs. Stroke (Stroke Vs**

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### **Mini-Stroke TIA Comparison)**

Alternate index label for Stroke vs Mini-Stroke TIA Comparison.

### **Miscarriage Causes And Symptoms**

Miscarriage is loss of a pregnancy before viability and may cause vaginal bleeding, cramping, passage of tissue, or no symptoms. Causes often involve chromosomal abnormalities, but evaluation considers ectopic pregnancy, infection, uterine factors, and recurrent-loss conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Abortion Spontaneous (Miscarriage Causes And Symptoms)

### **Misophonia**

Misophonia is an intense emotional or physiologic reaction to specific repetitive sounds, such as chewing or tapping. It is not simple annoyance; behavioral strategies, sound management, and therapy can reduce impairment, while assessment considers anxiety, obsessive-compulsive symptoms, and sensory sensitivity.

### **Moderate To Severe Disabilities**

Moderate to severe disability describes substantial limitations in physical, cognitive, sensory, communication, or adaptive functioning that require ongoing support. Needs vary widely and may include medical care, rehabilitation, assistive technology, education, and assistance with daily activities.

### **Mold Exposure**

Mold exposure can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways and may worsen asthma or allergic rhinitis; invasive infection is uncommon and mainly affects severely immunocompromised people. Reducing moisture and remediating contaminated areas are more useful than unproven detoxification.

### **Moles**

Moles are common collections of pigment-producing melanocytes and are usually benign. A lesion that changes in size, shape, color, symmetry, or symptoms, or differs markedly from others, should be examined for melanoma.

### **Molluscum Contagiosum Facts**

Molluscum contagiosum is a contagious poxvirus infection causing small, firm, centrally indented skin bumps. It often resolves spontaneously, but treatment may be considered for discomfort, spread, eczema, genital lesions, or immune suppression.

### **Monilia Infection Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children)**

Alternate index label for Thrush and Other Yeast Infections in Children.

### **Mono (Infectious Mononucleosis)**

Alternate index label for Infectious Mononucleosis.

### **Mononucleosis Contagious (Is Mononucleosis (Mono) Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Mononucleosis (Mono) Contagious.

### **Morgellons Disease**

Morgellons is a controversial condition involving distressing skin sensations and the belief that fibers or materials emerge from the skin. Symptoms are real to the person and require respectful evaluation for dermatologic, neurologic, psychiatric, toxic, or infectious causes without reinforcing an unproven explanation.

### **Mortons Neuroma (Morton's Neuroma)**

Alternate index label for Morton's Neuroma.

### **Motion Sickness (Sea Sickness, Car Sickness)**

Alternate index label for Sea Sickness, Car Sickness.

### **Motor Fluctuations Causes In Parkinson's Disease**

Motor fluctuations in Parkinson disease are changes between good mobility and wearing-off or medication-related involuntary movements as dopamine treatment duration and disease progression change. Adjusting timing, formulations, adjunct medicines, infusion, or surgery may help.

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### **MPS I (MPS I Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I Hurler Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for MPS I Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I Hurler Syndrome.

### **MPS I Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I Hurler Syndrome**

Mucopolysaccharidosis type I is an inherited lysosomal storage disease caused by alpha-L-iduronidase deficiency. Hurler syndrome is the severe form, with developmental regression, skeletal and airway disease, organ enlargement, corneal clouding, and cardiac involvement; early specialist treatment matters.

#### **Synonyms:**

MPS I (MPS I Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I Hurler Syndrome)

### **MPS II Mucopolysaccharidosis II Hunter Syndrome (Hunter Syndrome Mucopolysaccharidosis II MPS)**

Alternate index label for Hunter Syndrome Mucopolysaccharidosis II MPS.

### **MRSA Contagious (Is MRSA Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is MRSA Contagious.

### **MRSA Infection**

Methicillin-resistant *Staphylococcus aureus* is a strain of staphylococcus resistant to several beta-lactam antibiotics. It can colonize without illness or cause skin, wound, lung, bone, joint, or bloodstream infection; culture-guided treatment and hygiene reduce spread.

#### **Synonyms:**

Methicillin-Resistant *Staphylococcus Aureus* Infection

### **MS (Multiple Sclerosis (MS))**

Alternate index label for Multiple Sclerosis (MS).

### **MS (Multiple Sclerosis) Symptoms And Treatments**

Alternate index label for Multiple Sclerosis) Symptoms and Treatment.

toms and Treatment.

### **MS Alternative And Complementary Therapies (Alternative Therapy For Multiple Sclerosis)**

Alternate index label for Alternative Therapy for Multiple Sclerosis.

### **MS Contagious (Is MS Contagious Multiple Sclerosis Transmission)**

Alternate index label for Is MS Contagious Multiple Sclerosis Transmission.

### **MSBP (Munchausen Syndrome By Proxy)**

Alternate index label for Munchausen Syndrome by Proxy.

### **Mucinous Cyst Adenomas Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

### **Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome (Kawasaki Disease)**

Alternate index label for Kawasaki Disease.

### **Mucopolysaccharidosis II Hunter Syndrome (Hunter Syndrome Mucopolysaccharidosis II MPS)**

Alternate index label for Hunter Syndrome Mucopolysaccharidosis II MPS.

### **Multidrug-Resistant Extensively Drug-Resistant TB**

Multidrug-resistant tuberculosis is resistant to key first-line drugs, while extensively drug-resistant TB has additional resistance that greatly limits options. Diagnosis requires molecular or culture testing, and treatment uses prolonged individualized combinations with public-health oversight.

### **Multiple Myeloma: Deadly To Chronic**

Multiple myeloma is a plasma-cell cancer that produces a monoclonal protein and can cause bone lesions, anemia, kidney injury, high calcium, infection, and Treatment.

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tions, and fatigue. It is often treatable as a chronic illness, though relapse and complications remain possible.

### **Multiple Sclerosis (MS)**

Alternate index label for MS.

### **Multiple Sclerosis MS And Pregnancy**

Multiple sclerosis usually does not prevent pregnancy, but symptoms, disease-modifying medicines, relapse risk, delivery planning, and postpartum care require coordination. Some treatments must be stopped or changed, and relapse risk can shift after delivery.

### **Multiple Sclerosis MS Early Signs And Types**

Multiple sclerosis is an immune-mediated disease of the central nervous system with episodes or progression of visual, sensory, motor, balance, bladder, cognitive, or fatigue symptoms. Relapsing, progressive, and other patterns guide testing and treatment.

### **Murmur Congenital (Heart Murmur)**

Alternate index label for Heart Murmur.

### **Murmur Heart (Heart Murmur)**

Alternate index label for Heart Murmur.

### **Muscle Spasms**

Muscle spasms are sudden involuntary contractions caused by exertion, dehydration, electrolyte disturbance, nerve disease, medicines, pregnancy, or musculoskeletal problems. Recurrent, widespread, painful, or weakness-associated spasms need evaluation for an underlying cause.

### **Muscular Dystrophy: Symptoms, Causes And Types**

Muscular dystrophies are inherited disorders causing progressive muscle fiber weakness and degeneration. Different types vary in age of onset, inheritance, heart and breathing involvement, contractures, and progression; genetic diagnosis, rehabilitation, and cardiac and respiratory monitoring are important.

### **Myelodysplastic Or Myeloproliferative Neoplasms**

Myelodysplastic and myeloproliferative neoplasms are clonal bone-marrow disorders causing abnormal blood-cell production. They may produce anemia, infection, bleeding, high counts, enlarged spleen, thrombosis, or progression to acute leukemia; classification and mutation testing guide care.

### **Myelodysplastic Syndromes (MDS)**

Alternate index label for MDS.

### **Myocardial Infarction (Heart Attack)**

Alternate index label for Heart Attack.

### **MAB**

Abbreviation for monoclonal antibody; the suffix *-mab* in a generic drug name indicates a monoclonal antibody, such as adalimumab or rituximab.

### **Macerate**

To soften tissue by soaking and enzymatic digestion, as may occur in a stillborn fetus after death.

### **Macewen Sign**

An unusually resonant sound produced by percussion of the skull near the junction of the frontal, temporal, and parietal bones, classically associated with hydrocephalus or a brain abscess.

### **Machine, CPM**

A continuous passive motion machine that repeatedly moves a limb, such as a surgically treated knee, through a prescribed range of motion while the patient relaxes.

### **Machupo Virus**

An arenavirus that causes Bolivian hemorrhagic fever, a potentially fatal illness characterized by fever, pain, and bleeding; it is endemic in parts of Bolivia.

### **Macro- (Prefix)**

A prefix meaning large, abnormally large, or on a large scale, as in macrocytic, meaning involving



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abnormally large cells.

### **Macroangiopathy**

Disease of large blood vessels, often involving atherosclerotic buildup or thrombosis that narrows or blocks blood flow; examples include coronary, cerebrovascular, and peripheral vascular disease.

### **Macrobiotic**

Relating to the macrobiota, the living organisms in a region that are large enough to be seen with the naked eye.

### **Macrocytic**

Describing a cell, especially a red blood cell, that is abnormally large; macrocytic anemia features enlarged red blood cells.

### **Macrogenitosomia**

Premature or abnormal enlargement of the external genitalia, usually associated with a hormonal disorder that may also affect the internal sex organs.

### **Macrognathia**

Abnormal enlargement of the jaw, which may be associated with pituitary gigantism, tumors, or other disorders; also called a prognathic mandible.

### **Macular (Skin)**

Relating to a macule, a small, flat, circumscribed change in skin color that is neither raised nor depressed.

### **Macular Cyst**

A cystic defect in the macula, the central retinal area responsible for sharp vision, often associated with vitreous traction and potentially causing distortion or loss of central vision.

### **Macules**

Small, flat, circumscribed changes in skin color that are neither raised nor depressed; they are distinguished from raised papules and fluid-filled vesicles.

### **Magic Bullet**

An idealized treatment that selectively cures a disease with little or no harm to the patient; the term was introduced by Paul Ehrlich in connection with targeted treatment of infection.

### **Magnet Therapy**

An alternative therapy that places magnets on or near the body to relieve pain or treat disease. Scientific evidence does not support the claimed therapeutic benefits.

### **Major**

Larger, greater, or more significant than another related structure or condition; for example, the teres major muscle is larger than the teres minor muscle.

### **Male Genitalia**

The external and internal reproductive organs of a male, including the penis, scrotum, testes, epididymides, vas deferens, seminal vesicles, prostate, and associated ducts and glands.

### **Male Pelvis**

The lower part of the abdomen between the hip bones in a male; compared with the female pelvis, it is generally narrower, taller, and more robust, with a narrower pubic arch and sacrum.

### **Manic-Depression**

An older term for bipolar disorder, a mood disorder characterized by episodes of mania or hypomania and episodes of depression.

### **Manorexia**

An informal, nonmedical term sometimes used for anorexia nervosa in males; it is not an officially recognized diagnostic term.

### **MAOI**

Abbreviation for monoamine oxidase inhibitor, a drug that inhibits monoamine oxidase and is used in selected treatment of depression and other disorders.

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## MAP

Common abbreviation for *Mycobacterium avium* subspecies *paratuberculosis*, an organism of the *M. avium* complex; the abbreviation can have other meanings in different clinical contexts.

## Map-Dot-Fingerprint Type Corneal Dystrophy

A usually bilateral corneal epithelial basement membrane dystrophy producing map-like, dot-like, or fingerprint-like patterns and sometimes recurrent corneal erosions or visual blurring.

## Mapping

Charting the location of genes or other identifiable regions on chromosomes; the term may also describe charting functional or anatomical regions in other medical contexts.

## Marie-Strumpell Disease

Ankylosing spondylitis, a chronic inflammatory disease primarily affecting the sacroiliac joints and spine that can cause back pain, stiffness, and progressive spinal fusion.

## Marker

An identifiable biological feature used to track a gene, cell, disease, or process; a genetic marker is a detectable DNA region inherited with a nearby gene, while a blood or tumor marker is a measurable substance associated with a condition.

## Marker, Blood

A measurable sign of a disease or condition that can be isolated or detected in a blood sample, such as a disease-associated antibody, hormone, protein, or other substance.

## MASA Syndrome

An X-linked neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by intellectual disability, absent or limited speech, shuffling gait, spasticity, and adducted or clasped thumbs; it may also include short stature and lumbar lordosis. The name is an older acronym and terminology should be used sensitively.

## Masklike Face

An expressionless face with little spontaneous animation, also called masklike facies; it may occur in Parkinson disease, myotonic dystrophy, and other disorders.

## Maternal Serum Alpha-Fetoprotein (MSAFP)

A blood test measuring alpha-fetoprotein in a pregnant person's serum, usually during the second trimester, used as a screening component for fetal conditions such as open neural-tube defects and certain chromosomal abnormalities; an abnormal result requires appropriate follow-up rather than serving as a diagnosis by itself.

## Materteral

Relating to a maternal aunt or to the genetic relationship between an aunt and her niece or nephew; synonymous with materterine.

## MB ChB

Abbreviation for Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery, a medical degree awarded in many countries.

## McBurney's Point

A surface point in the right lower abdomen, classically near the junction of the lateral and middle thirds of a line from the anterior superior iliac spine to the umbilicus, where maximal tenderness may occur in acute appendicitis.

## MCD

An abbreviation with several medical meanings, including minimal change disease, mean corpuscular diameter, and medullary cystic disease; the intended meaning depends on context.

## MCH

Mean corpuscular hemoglobin: the calculated average amount of hemoglobin in each red blood cell, reported as part of a complete blood count.

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## MCHC

Mean corpuscular hemoglobin concentration: the calculated average concentration of hemoglobin in a given volume of packed red blood cells, derived from hemoglobin and hematocrit values and reported in a complete blood count.

## MCP

Membrane cofactor protein, also called CD46, is a cell-surface protein that regulates complement activation and helps protect host cells from complement-mediated injury; the abbreviation can have other meanings in different contexts.

## MCV

Mean corpuscular volume: the calculated average volume of a red blood cell, derived from hematocrit and red-cell count and reported as part of a complete blood count.

## MDI

An abbreviation that may mean metered-dose inhaler, multiple daily injections, or mental developmental index; the intended meaning depends on context.

## MDMA

3,4-Methylenedioxymethamphetamine, a psychoactive stimulant and hallucinogen commonly known as ecstasy or molly; it can produce serious cardiovascular, neurologic, and temperature-regulation effects.

## Me-Too Drug

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to me-too drug; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Mean Cell Volume

The average volume of a red blood cell, calculated from the hematocrit and red-cell count and reported as MCV in a complete blood count.

## Meatus, Female Urethral

The external opening of the female urethra, through which urine leaves the body; it is located anterior and superior to the vaginal opening.

## Medical Entomology

The study of insects and related arthropods that cause disease or transmit disease-causing organisms to humans, including their biology, ecology, physiology, and genetics.

## Medical Etymology

The study of the origins and historical development of medical words and terms, including their roots, prefixes, suffixes, and changes in meaning.

## Medical Geography

The study of how diseases, health, health-care resources, and health-related environmental factors are distributed and vary across geographic areas and populations.

## Medical Prefix

A prefix used in medical terminology to modify a word's meaning; examples include *hyper-* (above or excessive), *hypo-* (below or deficient), *macro-* (large), and *micro-* (small).

## Medical Profession

A vocation requiring specialized medical knowledge, an ethical code, continuing learning, and a duty to place patient care and public service above self-interest.

## Medical Repository

The first medical magazine and scientific journal published in the United States; founded in New York in 1797, it was published quarterly until 1824.

## Medical School

An institution whose curriculum leads to a medical degree and includes foundational sciences, clinical training, patient care, and often medical research.

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## Medical Symbol

A commonly recognized sign representing medicine, especially the Rod of Asclepius: a staff with one serpent. The winged, two-serpent caduceus is often used incorrectly as a medical symbol.

## Medication

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to medication; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Medifast Diet

A commercial calorie-restricted weight-loss program based largely on portion-controlled meal-replacement products; its safety and suitability depend on individual health needs and professional guidance.

## MEDLARS

Medical Literature Analysis and Retrieval System, an electronic bibliographic system developed by the U.S. National Library of Medicine to index and retrieve biomedical literature; it preceded MEDLINE.

## MEDVAC

Abbreviation for medical evacuation: the transport of ill or injured people to a medical facility or to a location providing a higher level of care.

## Mega- (Prefix)

A prefix derived from Greek meaning large, great, or abnormally enlarged, as in megacolon, megacardia, and megaloccephaly.

## Melan- (Prefix)

A combining form meaning dark or black, derived from the Greek *melas*; it refers especially to melanin or dark pigmentation, as in melanoma and melanocyte.

## Melanoderma

Increased pigmentation or darkening of the skin caused by increased melanin production or an increased number of melanocytes.

## Melanoma, Benign

An older or imprecise term for a benign melanocytic growth, such as a melanocytic nevus or mole; unlike malignant melanoma, it is not cancerous.

## MELD

Model for End-Stage Liver Disease, a laboratory-based score used to estimate severity of advanced liver disease and help prioritize adults for liver transplantation. Traditional versions use bilirubin, creatinine, and INR; current implementations may include additional variables.

## Melissophobia

An excessive or irrational fear of bees, also called apiphobia; it is a specific phobia that can cause avoidance, anxiety, or panic.

## Memory Span

The number of items, such as words or digits, that a person can briefly retain and recall, usually in the original order; it is a measure of short-term or working memory.

## Mendelism

The principles of inheritance based on Gregor Mendel's work, including segregation of alleles and independent assortment of genes; Mendelian traits may follow autosomal or X-linked dominant or recessive patterns.

## Menometrorrhagia

Excessive uterine bleeding occurring both at expected menstrual times and at irregular intervals; the older term corresponds broadly to heavy and irregular menstrual bleeding and warrants evaluation for underlying causes.

## Menstruation, Cessation Of

Cessation of menstrual periods, called amenorrhea; it is a normal part of menopause but may also result from pregnancy, illness, endocrine disorders, medications, stress, excessive exercise, or inadequate nutrition.

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## Met

Abbreviation for methionine, an essential sulfur-containing amino acid; it is also represented by the one-letter code M and the codons AUG.

## Methylenedioxymethamphetamine

3,4-Methylenedioxymethamphetamine, abbreviated MDMA and commonly called ecstasy or molly, is a psychoactive drug with stimulant and hallucinogenic effects that increases serotonergic signaling and can cause serious toxicity.

## MG (Myasthenia Gravis)

An autoimmune disorder of neuromuscular transmission that causes fluctuating, fatigable weakness, often affecting the eyes, facial muscles, swallowing, speech, or limbs; antibodies commonly target acetylcholine receptors or related proteins.

## MI

Abbreviation for myocardial infarction, or heart attack: death of heart-muscle tissue caused by prolonged inadequate blood flow, usually from acute coronary artery blockage.

## Miasma

A poisonous vapor or foul-smelling mist once believed to arise from decomposing matter and cause disease; the miasma theory is historically important but scientifically incorrect.

## Microangiopathy

Disease of small blood vessels, especially capillaries, in which vessel walls become thickened or damaged, impairing flow and allowing leakage or bleeding; diabetes is a common cause.

## Microorchidism

Abnormally small testes, which may result from impaired development, genetic syndromes, or testicular atrophy after injury or infection.

## Microphallus

An abnormally small penis, also called micropenis, usually defined relative to age and developmental

standards; it may reflect hormonal or developmental disorders.

## Microscopic Anatomy

The study of cells, tissues, and fine structural details that require magnification for examination; it includes cytology and histology.

## Microvascular

Relating to the microvasculature, the network of small blood vessels—generally those with an internal diameter of about 100 micrometers or less—including arterioles, capillaries, and venules.

## Midnight Disease

An older term for hypergraphia, an unusual or excessive drive to write, sometimes associated with temporal-lobe epilepsy or other neurologic or psychiatric conditions.

## Migrainous Neuralgia

An older term for cluster headache, a disorder causing recurrent attacks of severe unilateral pain, usually around one eye, with ipsilateral autonomic symptoms such as tearing or nasal congestion.

## Miller's Lung

Hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhaling material associated with the granary weevil (wheat weevil, *Sitophilus granarius*), especially in people working with contaminated grain or flour.

## Milligray

A unit of absorbed ionizing-radiation dose equal to one-thousandth of a gray, or 0.001 joule per kilogram; its abbreviation is mGy.

## Mimesis

Imitation or mimicry; in medicine, the term can refer to simulation of an organic disease by psychological symptoms or to one organic disease resembling another.

## Mind

The collection of mental processes and capacities in-

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involved in consciousness, thought, perception, memory, emotion, judgment, and behavior.

### Minor

Smaller, lesser, or less significant than a related structure or condition; for example, the teres minor muscle is smaller than the teres major muscle.

### Mitochondrial DNA Depletion Syndrome MDS MDDS

A group of inherited disorders in which affected tissues contain abnormally reduced amounts of mitochondrial DNA, impairing cellular energy production. Forms may predominantly affect muscle, liver, or brain and muscle; many are autosomal recessive.

### Mixed-Lineage Leukemia

An acute leukemia in which the malignant blasts show defining features of more than one hematopoietic lineage, commonly both myeloid and lymphoid; it is also called mixed-phenotype acute leukemia.

### MM

An abbreviation that may mean meningocele, malignant melanoma, or multiple myeloma; in low-ercase, *mm* commonly means millimeter. The intended meaning depends on context.

### MME

Membrane metalloendopeptidase, also called neprilysin, CD10, neutral endopeptidase, or CALLA; it is a cell-surface enzyme and marker expressed in several tissues and in some acute lymphoblastic leukemias.

### Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitor

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to monoamine oxidase inhibitor; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### Monoclonal

Derived from a single cell and therefore composed of cells or molecules that are genetically or immunologically identical to that original cell; monoclonal

antibodies recognize one target or epitope.

### Monosodium Glutamate

MSG, the sodium salt of glutamic acid, used as a flavor enhancer because it contributes umami taste; it occurs naturally in foods such as tomatoes and aged cheese.

### Morpheus

The Greek and Roman mythological god of dreams; the name is the source of *morphine*, an opioid named for its association with sleep and dreams.

### Morphology

The study or description of the form, shape, and structural features of organisms, organs, tissues, cells, or other biological structures.

### Mosaic

Describing a person or tissue composed of two or more genetically different cell populations derived from one zygote, often because of a post-zygotic mutation or chromosomal event; mosaicism can alter the severity and distribution of a genetic disorder.

### MP

Abbreviation for mercaptopurine, a purine-antimetabolite drug, or for molecular pathology; the intended meaning depends on context.

### MPH

Master of Public Health, a graduate degree focused on population health, disease prevention, health policy, epidemiology, and related public-health practice.

### MPO

Myeloperoxidase, an enzyme in neutrophil and monocyte granules that uses hydrogen peroxide and halide ions to generate antimicrobial oxidants; MPO antibodies are also used in evaluating some autoimmune vasculitides.

### MPS

Abbreviation for mucopolysaccharidosis, a group



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of inherited lysosomal storage disorders caused by deficient breakdown of glycosaminoglycans.

### **MRA**

Magnetic resonance angiography, a noninvasive MRI-based technique that produces images of blood vessels and can help evaluate aneurysms, stenoses, malformations, and atherosclerosis.

### **MRC**

Abbreviation for the Medical Reserve Corps in the United States or the Medical Research Council in the United Kingdom and some Commonwealth countries.

### **MRCP**

Magnetic resonance cholangiopancreatography, an MRI technique that noninvasively images the bile ducts, gallbladder, and pancreatic duct without requiring endoscopic catheterization.

### **MRD**

Minimal residual disease: a small number of malignant cells remaining after treatment, detectable by sensitive methods such as flow cytometry or PCR even when routine tests show remission.

### **MS/MS**

Tandem mass spectrometry, an analytical technique in which ions are selected, fragmented, and analyzed by a second stage of mass spectrometry; it is used to identify and quantify molecules in clinical and research samples.

### **MSAFP (Maternal Serum Alpha-Fetoprotein)**

A maternal blood test measuring alpha-fetoprotein during pregnancy, used as a screening component for fetal conditions such as open neural-tube defects and some chromosomal abnormalities; an abnormal result requires follow-up and is not diagnostic by itself.

### **MSG**

Abbreviation for monosodium glutamate, the

sodium salt of glutamic acid used as a flavor enhancer and contributing umami taste.

### **MST**

Multiple subpial transection, a neurosurgical procedure in which shallow cuts are made in the cerebral cortex to interrupt seizure pathways when the epileptogenic region cannot safely be removed.

### **MTX**

Abbreviation for methotrexate, a folate-antagonist drug used in selected cancers, autoimmune diseases, and other conditions.

### **Mucous**

Relating to mucus, the viscous fluid produced by mucous membranes and glands that lubricates surfaces and helps trap particles and microorganisms.

### **Multicentric**

Having more than one center or focus; in oncology, describing separate primary tumor foci, often also called multifocal or polycentric.

### **Multidetector Computed Tomography**

MDCT is CT imaging using a two-dimensional array of detector elements to acquire multiple slices simultaneously, increasing acquisition speed and enabling high-resolution applications such as CT angiography and virtual colonoscopy.

### **Multifocal**

Arising from or involving two or more distinct foci or sites, such as separate tumor foci or vascular lesions.

### **Multipara**

A person who has had two or more pregnancies that reached the stage of potential fetal viability, regardless of whether the pregnancies resulted in live births.

### **Multiple System Failure**

Failure of two or more organ systems, also called multiple-organ failure or multiple-organ dysfunction

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syndrome; it may occur during severe illness such as sepsis, shock, or major trauma.

### **Mute**

Describing a person who does not speak, whether because of a physical, neurologic, developmental, or psychological reason or by choice; current clinical language should describe the specific communication limitation or preference.

### **MVP**

Abbreviation for mitral valve prolapse, in which one or both mitral-valve leaflets bow into the left atrium during ventricular systole; it is often mild but can sometimes cause mitral regurgitation or arrhythmias.

### **Myc-**

A combining form meaning fungus or pertaining to fungi, derived from the Greek *mykes*; examples include mycosis and mycology.

### **Myco-**

The term Myco- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Myeloencephalitis**

Myeloencephalitis is inflammation involving the spinal cord and brain, caused by infection, immune disease, toxins, or other neurologic processes.

### **Myeloperoxidase**

A biomedical term referring to myeloperoxidase; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **MYH**

MYH is a gene-family abbreviation involving myosin or DNA-repair proteins; the specific gene and variant determine the clinical meaning.

### **Myo- (Prefix)**

A medical term referring to myo- (prefix). Its clinical

meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myotonic Dystrophy Type 2**

A medical term referring to myotonic dystrophy type 2. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Myriad**

Myriad means a very large or indefinite number; in healthcare writing, specific counts or ranges are preferable when they are known.

### **Mammary Glands (Breasts)**

Paired glands of the anterior chest that produce milk after childbirth. Each breast contains lobules, ducts, connective tissue, and fat and is influenced by hormonal and reproductive changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

breasts; mammary glands

### **Mouth (Oral Cavity)**

The entry to the digestive tract, containing the teeth, tongue, and openings of salivary glands. It supports chewing, taste, swallowing, speech, and initial digestion.

#### **Synonyms:**

oral cavity; mouth

### **Milk Allergy**

An immune reaction to proteins in cow's milk that may cause skin, gastrointestinal, or respiratory symptoms and, rarely, anaphylaxis.

### **Mold Allergy**

An allergic response to mold spores that may cause nasal, eye, skin, or lower-respiratory symptoms.

### **Mouth Cancer**

Cancer arising in the lips, gums, tongue, cheeks, floor of the mouth, palate, or other oral tissues.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Mouth

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## Myocardial Ischemia

Reduced blood flow and oxygen supply to heart muscle, usually from narrowed coronary arteries, potentially causing chest pain or heart damage.

### Synonyms:

Cardiac Ischemia

## Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome (MALS)

Compression of the celiac artery and nearby nerves by the median arcuate ligament, potentially causing post-meal abdominal pain and weight loss.

### Synonyms:

Dunbar Syndrome MALS

## Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome In Children (MIS-C)

A serious inflammatory condition occurring after SARS-CoV-2 infection, affecting multiple organs and sometimes causing shock or cardiac dysfunction.

## Mandible (Lower Jaw)

The large movable bone forming the lower jaw and carrying the lower teeth.

### Synonyms:

Lower Jaw

## Maxilla (Upper Jaw)

The paired bones forming the upper jaw, the front part of the hard palate, and parts of the walls of the nose and eye sockets.

### Synonyms:

Upper Jaw

## Mucosal Warts

HPV-associated warts arising on mucous membranes, including the oral, genital, or anorectal mucosa.

## MINOCA

Myocardial infarction with non-obstructive coronary arteries: an acute myocardial infarction with no coronary stenosis of 50 percent or greater and no other immediately apparent cause for the presentation. It is a working diagnosis requiring evaluation

for mechanisms such as plaque disruption, coronary spasm, coronary embolism, spontaneous coronary artery dissection, myocarditis, or Takotsubo syndrome.

## Maternal Vaccine

A vaccine given during pregnancy to protect the pregnant person and, through transferred antibodies, provide early protection to the fetus or newborn; recommended products and timing depend on current guidance.

## Myotonia

Delayed relaxation of a muscle after voluntary contraction or stimulation, often caused by an inherited or acquired muscle-channel disorder.

## Metabolic Myopathies

Muscle disorders caused by impaired energy metabolism, often producing exercise intolerance, cramps, weakness, muscle pain, or episodes of rhabdomyolysis.

## Mandibular Advancement Device

An oral appliance that holds the lower jaw or tongue forward during sleep to enlarge or stabilize the upper airway, usually for selected patients with obstructive sleep apnea or snoring.

## Microcystic Adnexal Carcinoma

A rare, slow-growing but locally aggressive malignant adnexal tumor, usually on the head or neck, with follicular and ductal differentiation; it may extend deeply and requires complete excision.

## Myofibroblastoma Of The Breast

A rare benign stromal tumor composed of spindle-shaped myofibroblastic cells, usually occurring in older adults. It is typically a well-circumscribed painless mass and is diagnosed by histology with immunohistochemistry.

## Mammary Paget Disease

An intraepidermal spread of malignant glandular cells into the nipple epidermis, usually associated

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with underlying breast carcinoma and presenting as persistent eczematous or crusted nipple change.

### **Mucosal Melanoma**

A melanoma arising from melanocytes in mucosal surfaces such as the sinonasal tract, oral cavity, anorectal region, or genital tract; it is uncommon and often diagnosed at an advanced stage.

### **Mucous Membrane Pemphigoid**

A chronic autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease affecting mucous membranes, especially the eyes and mouth; scarring can impair vision or function.

### **Metastases To The Breast**

Secondary malignant deposits in breast tissue from a nonmammary primary tumor, most often melanoma, lymphoma, or carcinoma from another organ. Imaging and biopsy are needed because the treatment differs from primary breast carcinoma.

### **Male Breast Pathology**

Disorders affecting male breast tissue, including gynecomastia, benign epithelial lesions, inflammatory conditions, and carcinoma. Evaluation of a persistent mass or nipple change requires clinical examination and appropriate imaging, with biopsy when indicated.

### **Undifferentiated Pleomorphic Sarcoma Of The Breast**

A rare high-grade breast sarcoma formerly called malignant fibrous histiocytoma. It is a diagnosis of exclusion after other specific sarcomas and metastatic carcinoma have been ruled out histologically.

### **Milan System For Reporting Salivary Gland Cytopathology**

A standardized six-category framework for salivary-gland fine-needle aspiration, reporting nondiagnostic, non-neoplastic, benign neoplasm, uncertain, suspicious, and malignant findings with associated risk estimates.

### **Molecular Pathology Of Colorectal**

### **Cancer**

The assessment of molecular alterations that classify colorectal tumors and guide prognosis or therapy, including mismatch-repair deficiency or microsatellite instability, RAS mutations, BRAF mutation, HER2 amplification, and selected gene fusions.

### **Myofibroblastoma**

A benign mesenchymal tumor composed of myofibroblastic cells in collagenous or myxoid stroma, most often arising in the mammary or inguinal region but potentially occurring at other soft-tissue sites.

### **Myoepithelioma Of Soft Tissue**

A rare soft-tissue neoplasm showing myoepithelial differentiation, ranging from benign to malignant. Diagnosis uses morphology and immunohistochemistry, with treatment guided by behavior and complete excision.

### **Malignant Giant Cell Tumor Of Tendon Sheath**

A rare locally aggressive malignant tumor resembling a giant cell tumor of tendon sheath, characterized by destructive growth and potential for metastasis; diagnosis requires expert soft-tissue pathology review.

### **Mesenchymal Tumor Of The Central Nervous System**

A tumor arising from non-neural supporting tissues of the CNS, including meningeal, vascular, fibroblastic, or other mesenchymal lineages. Diagnosis requires correlation of morphology, immunophenotype, molecular findings, and site.

### **Melanocytic Tumor Of The Central Nervous System**

A tumor showing melanocytic differentiation within the CNS or meninges, ranging from benign melanocytoma to malignant melanoma. Evaluation includes imaging, histology, and molecular assessment to determine behavior.

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### **Massive Ovarian Edema**

Marked stromal edema causing enlargement of one or both ovaries, usually due to partial torsion or hormonal stimulation. It can mimic an ovarian neoplasm and may cause pain or virilization.

### **Mucinous Cyst Of The Vulva**

A benign mucus-filled cyst of the vulva, arising from obstruction or metaplastic mucinous epithelium in a vulvar gland or duct; persistent or atypical masses require examination and possible biopsy.

### **Minimally Invasive Gastrointestinal Surgery**

Gastrointestinal operations performed through small incisions or natural orifices using laparoscopic, robotic, or endoscopic techniques, often reducing recovery time while retaining procedure-specific risks.

### **Mast Cell Sarcoma**

An exceptionally rare, aggressive neoplasm composed of immature or atypical mast cells forming a destructive mass in tissue or bone. Unlike systemic mastocytosis, it is characterized by a localized sarcomatous tumor and may progress to disseminated mast-cell disease or acute leukemia. Clinical manifestations depend on the involved site and may include pain, swelling, organ dysfunction, or mediator-related symptoms such as flushing and hypotension. Diagnosis requires histopathology, mast-cell immunophenotyping, and systemic staging; management generally involves specialist-directed intensive antineoplastic therapy.





## N

### **Nullipara**

A person who has never carried a pregnancy beyond the stage of fetal viability; the adjective is nulliparous.

### **N-Acetylcysteine**

An antidote that replenishes glutathione and enhances detoxification of the toxic metabolite of acetaminophen. It is most effective when started early but may benefit patients with delayed presentation or established liver injury under specialist guidance.

### **Nasolabial Folds**

Skin creases running from the sides of the nose toward the corners of the mouth.

### **Nabumetone**

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used to reduce pain and inflammation in selected musculoskeletal disorders.

### **Naevus**

The British spelling of nevus, a usually benign localized skin or mucosal lesion such as a mole.

### **Nalbuphine**

An opioid analgesic with mixed agonist-antagonist activity, used for moderate to severe pain.

### **Nalidixic Acid**

An older quinolone antibacterial formerly used for some urinary-tract infections.

### **Naloxone**

An opioid-receptor antagonist that rapidly reverses

opioid-induced respiratory depression.

### **Naltrexone**

A longer-acting opioid antagonist used in selected treatment of opioid or alcohol use disorder.

### **Nanism**

An older term for dwarfism or markedly short stature; modern usage specifies the underlying condition.

### **Nanosomia**

Abnormally small body size or stature; the term is uncommon and context-dependent.

### **Nantenine**

An alkaloid found in *Nandina domestica*; it has pharmacologic activity but is not a routine clinical medicine.

### **Napelline**

A toxic diterpenoid alkaloid related to aconite, capable of causing neurologic and cardiac poisoning.

### **Naphazoline**

A topical alpha-adrenergic agonist used as a nasal decongestant or ocular vasoconstrictor; prolonged use can worsen congestion.

### **Naproxen**

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain, fever, and inflammation.

### **Narcissism**

Excessive self-focus or need for admiration; clini-

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cally significant persistent patterns may occur in narcissistic personality disorder.

### **Narcotic**

A historical term for opioid drugs and, in legal usage, certain controlled substances; meaning varies by context.

### **Nasal**

Relating to the nose or nasal cavity.

### **Nasopharynx**

The upper part of the pharynx behind the nose, above the soft palate and connected to the auditory tubes.

### **Natriuresis**

Excretion of sodium in the urine.

### **Natriuretic**

Promoting urinary sodium excretion.

### **Necator**

A genus of hookworms that inhabit the small intestine and can cause iron-deficiency anemia.

### **Necator Americanus**

A hookworm species that infects humans through skin penetration by larvae and causes intestinal blood loss.

### **Neural**

Relating to nerves or the nervous system.

### **Neurilemma**

The outer nucleated layer of a Schwann cell surrounding a peripheral nerve fiber.

### **Neuritis**

Inflammation or injury of a nerve, causing pain, sensory change, weakness, or altered nerve function.

### **Neuroendocrine**

Relating to interaction between the nervous and

endocrine systems or to cells with both neural and hormone-related features.

### **Neurohormone**

A hormone released by a neuron or neurosecretory cell into the blood or surrounding tissue.

### **Neurohypophysis**

The posterior lobe of the pituitary gland, which stores and releases oxytocin and vasopressin.

### **Neurolathyrism**

A toxic neurologic disorder caused by excessive consumption of *Lathyrus sativus*, producing progressive spastic weakness of the legs.

### **Neurology**

The medical specialty concerned with diseases of the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and muscles.

### **Neurolysis**

Surgical or chemical freeing or destruction of a nerve, depending on context.

### **Neuroma**

A benign growth or reactive thickening involving nerve tissue, often producing pain or altered sensation.

### **Neuromuscular**

Relating to nerves and muscles or to their junction and communication.

### **Neurone**

The British spelling of neuron, an excitable nerve cell that receives and transmits signals.

### **Neuropeptide**

A peptide released by neurons that acts as a signaling molecule in the nervous or endocrine system.

### **Neuro-Ophthalmology**

The subspecialty dealing with visual disorders caused by the nervous system, optic nerve, or eye-movement pathways.

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## Neuropharmacology

The study of how medicines and other substances affect the nervous system.

## Neuroplegic

Causing paralysis or profound reduction of nervous or muscular activity; the term is uncommon.

## Neuropsychiatry

The clinical field linking neurologic and psychiatric disorders, including cognitive and behavioral consequences of brain disease.

## Neuroradiology

The use of imaging to diagnose disorders of the brain, spine, head and neck, and peripheral nerves.

## Neurosis

An obsolete broad term for nonpsychotic emotional distress; modern diagnosis uses specific anxiety, obsessive, or related disorders.

## Neurosurgery

Surgical treatment of disorders of the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and supporting structures.

## Neurotrophic

Relating to factors that support the growth, survival, or maintenance of nerve cells.

## Neurotropic

Having an affinity for or acting primarily on nervous tissue.

## Neutralization

Removal or reduction of an effect by counteraction, such as an acid-base reaction or antibody-antigen binding.

## Neutrophil

The most common circulating granulocyte, an innate immune cell important in early defense against bacterial and fungal infection.

## Newborn

An infant in the neonatal period, conventionally the first 28 days after birth.

## Niacin

Vitamin B3, required to form NAD and NADP coenzymes; deficiency causes pellagra.

## Niacinamide

The amide form of vitamin B3, used as a nutritional supplement and in selected dermatologic preparations.

## Nialamide

An older monoamine-oxidase-inhibitor antidepressant that is no longer commonly used.

## Nicardipine

A dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker used to lower blood pressure and treat selected vascular conditions.

## Niche

A specialized site or microenvironment supporting particular cells, organisms, or biological processes.

## Niclosamide

An anthelmintic used against selected tapeworm infections.

## Nicotinamide

Another name for niacinamide, a form of vitamin B3.

## Nicotinic

Relating to nicotine or to nicotinic acetylcholine receptors.

## Nictitating Membrane

A transparent or translucent third eyelid found in some animals; humans have only a small vestigial fold.

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**Nidation**

Implantation of a fertilized ovum into the uterine lining.

**Nifedipine**

A dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker used for hypertension, angina, and selected pregnancy-related hypertensive conditions.

**Night-Blindness**

Difficulty seeing in dim light, called nyctalopia; causes include vitamin A deficiency, retinal disease, and inherited disorders.

**Nightmares**

Disturbing, vivid dreams that cause fear or distress and may awaken the sleeper.

**Night-Sweats**

Episodes of excessive sweating during sleep; causes include infection, malignancy, hormonal change, medicines, and environmental heat.

**Nikethamide**

An obsolete respiratory stimulant with limited historical use and potential toxicity.

**Nikolsky's Sign**

Shearing or peeling of the superficial epidermis when apparently normal skin beside a blister is rubbed; it may occur in pemphigus and other blistering disorders.

**Niridazole**

An older antischistosomal medicine with significant adverse effects and limited current use.

**Nisbet's Canker**

A rare historical term whose clinical meaning is not consistent across references; the original source should be checked.

**Nisin**

An antimicrobial peptide produced by *Lactococcus lactis* and used mainly as a food preservative.

**Nitrazepam**

A benzodiazepine hypnotic with sedative and anticonvulsant effects; dependence and respiratory depression are risks.

**Nitric Acid**

A corrosive mineral acid that can cause severe chemical burns and toxic inhalational injury.

**Nitric Oxide**

A short-lived signaling molecule that relaxes vascular smooth muscle and participates in immune and neural signaling.

**Nitrofurantoin**

An antibacterial medicine used mainly for susceptible lower urinary-tract infections.

**Nitrogen**

An essential element in amino acids, proteins, nucleic acids, and other biological molecules; atmospheric nitrogen is largely inert to humans.

**Nitromors**

A trade name for paint or varnish stripper formulations; exposure can cause chemical burns or toxic inhalation.

**Nizatidine**

An H<sub>2</sub>-receptor antagonist that reduces gastric acid secretion; availability varies by country.

**No-Reflow Phenomenon**

Failure of microvascular perfusion to resume despite reopening of a previously blocked larger vessel, especially after myocardial infarction or stroke.

**Nociceptor**

A sensory receptor that detects potentially tissue-damaging mechanical, thermal, or chemical stimuli.

**Nocturnal**

Occurring during the night.

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### Nocturnal Enuresis

Involuntary urination during sleep in a child old enough for continence, without another defining lower urinary-tract disorder.

### Nodal Rhythm

A cardiac rhythm arising from the atrioventricular junction when the sinoatrial node does not control the heartbeat.

### Node

A localized swelling, structure, or point of connection; examples include lymph nodes and electrical conduction nodes.

### Nodular

Having or forming one or more nodules.

### Noise

Unwanted sound or signal that can interfere with communication, measurement, imaging, or hearing.

### Non-Articular Rheumatism

An older term for painful disorders of muscles, tendons, bursae, or other tissues outside the joints.

### Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma

A diverse group of malignant lymphoid tumors that may arise from B cells, T cells, or natural-killer cells.

### Non-Invasive Procedure

A procedure that does not intentionally enter a body cavity, organ, or tissue with an instrument.

### Non-Responder

A person or disease that shows little or no expected response to a treatment, vaccine, or test stimulus.

### Non-Specific Urethritis (NSU)

Urethral inflammation without identification of a specific cause, often associated with sexually transmitted organisms such as *Chlamydia trachomatis*.

### Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs

### (NSAIDs)

Medicines that inhibit cyclooxygenase and reduce prostaglandin production, providing analgesic, antipyretic, and anti-inflammatory effects.

### Norethisterone

A synthetic progestogen used for contraception and selected menstrual or endometriosis-related disorders.

### Norfloxacin

A quinolone antibiotic formerly used for selected urinary or gastrointestinal bacterial infections.

### Norgestrel

A synthetic progestogen used in some hormonal contraceptive preparations.

### Normal

Within an expected range or consistent with usual anatomy, physiology, or function for a specified population.

### Normal Saline

A sterile approximately 0.9

### Normoblast

A nucleated immature red-cell precursor in bone marrow that normally loses its nucleus before entering circulation.

### Normocytic Anaemia

Anemia in which red blood cells are of approximately normal mean volume, despite a reduced total red-cell mass.

### Normotensive

Having blood pressure within the expected range for the individual and measurement setting.

### Nortriptyline

A tricyclic antidepressant used for depression and selected neuropathic pain disorders.

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## Norwegian Scabies

A severe, highly contagious form of crusted scabies with large numbers of mites, often occurring in immunocompromised people.

## Nose, Disorders Of

Conditions affecting the nose or nasal passages, including infection, allergy, trauma, obstruction, polyps, and tumors.

## Nostril

One of the two external openings of the nose.

## Noxious

Harmful or capable of causing tissue injury or pain.

## Nuchal

Relating to the back of the neck.

## Nuclear

Relating to a cell nucleus, atomic nucleus, or nuclear medicine depending on context.

## Nuclear Magnetic Resonance (NMR)

The absorption and emission of electromagnetic energy by atomic nuclei in a magnetic field; it is the physical basis of MRI and spectroscopy.

## Nucleic Acid

DNA or RNA, polymers that store, transmit, or express genetic information.

## Nucleolus

A dense region within the cell nucleus where ribosomal RNA is produced and ribosome subunits begin assembly.

## Nucleoside

A nitrogenous base linked to a sugar, without a phosphate group.

## Nucleotide

A nucleoside linked to one or more phosphate groups; nucleotides form DNA and RNA and carry cellular

energy.

## Nucleus

The membrane-bound cell organelle containing most genetic material, or a defined cluster of neurons in the central nervous system.

## Nulligravida

A person who has never been pregnant.

## Numbness

Reduced or absent sensation, often caused by nerve compression, injury, neuropathy, circulation problems, or brain or spinal disease.

## Nummular

Coin-shaped or circular, as in nummular eczema.

## Nurse

A regulated healthcare professional who provides assessment, treatment, education, monitoring, and supportive care.

## Nursery

A place or service for the care of infants, including specialized newborn care in a hospital.

## Nursing

The professional practice of caring for people, promoting health, preventing illness, and supporting recovery or comfort.

## Nut

A seed or fruit used as food; it may cause IgE-mediated food allergy in susceptible people.

## Nut-Allergy

An immune-mediated reaction to one or more nuts, potentially causing urticaria, anaphylaxis, or gastrointestinal and respiratory symptoms.

## Nutation

A nodding or rocking movement; in anatomy it commonly describes movement of the sacrum relative to the pelvis.



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## Nutraceutical

A food-derived product marketed for health or medicinal benefit; quality, evidence, and regulation vary.

## Nutrient

A substance required by the body for energy, growth, repair, or physiological function.

## Nutriment

Food or nourishment that supports bodily maintenance and growth.

## Nutrition

The intake, digestion, absorption, metabolism, and use of food components by the body.

## Nutritional Disorders

Conditions caused by deficiency, excess, imbalance, or impaired use of nutrients.

## Nutritional Science

The study of nutrients, dietary patterns, metabolism, and their effects on health and disease.

## Nutritive

Providing nourishment or nutrients.

## Nux Vomica

The seed of *Strychnos nux-vomica*, containing strychnine and brucine; ingestion can cause severe convulsant poisoning.

## Nyctalgalia

Pain occurring at night; the term is uncommon and requires clinical context.

## Nycteralgia

Night pain, an uncommon term sometimes used interchangeably with nyctalgalia.

## Nyctalopia

Impaired vision in dim light or darkness, also called

night blindness.

## Nymphomania

An obsolete and stigmatizing term formerly used for excessive female sexual desire; modern assessment uses specific, nonjudgmental descriptions.

## Nerve Block

Injection of local anesthetic, sometimes with other agents, near a nerve or nerve plexus to interrupt pain signals.

## Nerve Endings

The terminal branches of sensory or motor nerves that detect stimuli or communicate with muscles and glands.

## Nerve Growth Factor

A neurotrophin that supports the survival, growth, and maintenance of selected sensory and sympathetic neurons.

## Nerve Injury

Damage to a peripheral or central nerve causing pain, numbness, weakness, altered reflexes, or autonomic dysfunction.

## Nerve-Muscle Preparation

An experimental isolated nerve and muscle arrangement used to study neuromuscular transmission and muscle contraction.

## Nerve Tract

A bundle of nerve fibers traveling together within the central nervous system.

## Nervous Breakdown

A nonmedical lay term for severe emotional or psychological distress; a clinician should assess for a specific mental or physical disorder.

## Nervous System

The brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and related cells that coordinate sensation, movement, autonomic function, cognition, and behavior.

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**Nervus**

Latin for nerve, used in anatomical names.

**Nettles**

Plants of the genus *Urtica* whose hairs inject irritants and cause transient stinging, itching, and wheals.

**Neoplasia**

Abnormal clonal proliferation of cells producing a new growth, called a neoplasm, that may be benign or malignant. Neoplastic growth persists beyond normal regulatory controls and may show genetic, epigenetic, morphologic, or functional abnormalities. Benign neoplasms are usually localized, whereas malignant neoplasms can invade adjacent tissues and metastasize to distant sites. Classification requires integration of morphology, immunophenotype, molecular findings, anatomic behavior, and clinical staging when applicable.

**Neoplastic**

Relating to a neoplasm or abnormal new growth of tissue.

**Neostigmine**

An acetylcholinesterase inhibitor used to reverse selected nondepolarizing neuromuscular blockade and to treat some disorders of neuromuscular transmission or bowel and bladder motility.

**Nephric**

Relating to the kidney or to embryonic kidney development.

**Nephritis**

Inflammation of kidney tissue, often affecting the glomeruli or interstitium and potentially impairing renal function.

**Nephrology**

The medical specialty concerned with kidney disease, fluid and electrolyte disorders, hypertension, dialysis, and kidney transplantation.

**Nephrolysis**

Surgical freeing of a kidney from surrounding adhesions or tissue.

**Nephoptosis**

Abnormal downward movement or mobility of a kidney, also called floating kidney.

**Nephrosclerosis**

Hardening and scarring of kidney tissue, commonly caused by long-standing hypertension or vascular disease.

**Nephrosis**

An older broad term for noninflammatory kidney disease, historically associated particularly with nephrotic states.

**Nicotine Replacement Therapy (NRT)**

Use of nicotine patches, gum, lozenges, spray, or inhaler to reduce withdrawal and cravings while stopping tobacco use.

**Notochord**

A flexible embryonic rod that guides axial development and largely disappears as the vertebral column forms.

**Notencephalocele**

A rare congenital neural-tube defect involving protrusion of brain tissue or meninges through a skull defect; terminology varies by source.

**Novobiocin**

An older aminocoumarin antibiotic formerly used for selected staphylococcal infections and in laboratory differentiation of staphylococci.

**Natural Killer Cells**

Immune cells that destroy infected or abnormal cells without prior exposure to a specific antigen.

**Synonyms:**

NK cells

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### **Needle Biopsy**

Removal of a small tissue sample through a hollow needle for microscopic examination.

### **Neonatal**

Relating to a newborn, especially during the first 28 days after birth.

### **Nephrologist**

Physician specializing in kidney diseases, including dialysis management and transplant care.

### **Nerve Sparing**

Surgical preservation of nerves needed for erectile function, especially during prostate surgery.

### **Neuritic Plaques**

Abnormal deposits of beta-amyloid surrounded by damaged nerve processes in Alzheimer disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Amyloid plaques

### **Neurofibrillary Tangles**

Twisted tau-protein fibers inside damaged neurons, characteristic of Alzheimer disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tau tangles

### **Neuroleptic Agents**

Antipsychotic medicines used to treat disorders such as schizophrenia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Antipsychotics

### **Neurologist**

A physician specializing in disorders of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, and muscles.

### **Neuropeptides**

Short chains of amino acids that act as signaling molecules in the nervous system.

### **Neurosurgeon**

Surgeon specializing in surgical treatment of disorders

of the brain, spine, and peripheral nerves.

### **Neurotransmitter Receptors**

Cell proteins that recognize neurotransmitters and alter cell activity when bound.

### **Neutral Alignment**

A posture in which the body is arranged in a straight, balanced line while preserving normal spinal curves.

### **Nonproliferative Retinopathy**

Retinal disease in which small vessels leak or become damaged without abnormal new-vessel growth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Background retinopathy

### **Non-REM Sleep**

Sleep stages that do not include rapid eye movements, including deep slow-wave sleep.

#### **Synonyms:**

NREM sleep

### **Noradrenaline**

A hormone and neurotransmitter involved in alertness, stress responses, and blood-vessel constriction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Norepinephrine

### **Norepinephrine**

A hormone and neurotransmitter that supports alertness, heart function, and the stress response.

#### **Synonyms:**

Noradrenaline

### **NSAID**

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used to reduce pain, fever, and inflammation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug

### **Nuclear Tests**

Diagnostic tests using small amounts of radioactive material to assess organs or identify disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Nuclear medicine tests

### **Na<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup> ATPase**

The sodium-potassium pump is a P-type ATPase found in the plasma membrane of all animal cells, directly consuming approximately 20-30 percent of cellular ATP. It pumps 3 Na<sup>+</sup> ions out of the cell and 2 K<sup>+</sup> ions in per ATP hydrolyzed, establishing steep electrochemical gradients: high Na<sup>+</sup> outside, high K<sup>+</sup> inside.

### **Nabothian Cyst**

A benign mucus-retention cyst of the uterine cervix caused by obstruction of an endocervical gland. It is common, usually asymptomatic, and generally requires no treatment.

### **NAD<sup>+</sup>**

Nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide in its oxidized form, a coenzyme that carries electrons in cellular energy metabolism.

### **NAD<sup>+</sup> (Nicotinamide Adenine Dinucleotide)**

Coenzyme involved in redox reactions, existing in oxidized (NAD<sup>+</sup>) and reduced (NADH) forms. Accepts electrons and hydrogen (NAD<sup>+</sup> + 2e<sup>-</sup> + H<sup>+</sup> → NADH). Key roles: glycolysis (glyceraldehyde-3-phosphate dehydrogenase), TCA cycle (isocitrate, alpha-ketoglutarate, malate dehydrogenases), beta-oxidation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nicotinamide Adenine Dinucleotide

### **Nadir**

The lowest point, particularly referring to the lowest white blood cell count after chemotherapy. Bone marrow suppression typically reaches nadir 7-14 days post-treatment. Important for infection risk assessment.

### **Naegle Rule**

A formula for estimating the due date (estimated date of delivery, EDD): add 7 days to the first day of the last menstrual period (LMP), then add 9 months (or subtract 3 months). Example: LMP

January 1 yields EDD October 8. Assumes a 28-day cycle with ovulation on day 14. The rule is most accurate with regular cycles and confirmed LMP.

### **Naegleria Fowleri**

A free-living amoeba that can cause primary amoebic meningoencephalitis after contaminated water enters the nose. The infection is rare but rapidly progressive, with fever, severe headache, meningism, altered consciousness, seizures, and high mortality.

### **Naegleria Infection**

A rare infection caused by the free-living amoeba *Naegleria fowleri*, usually acquired when contaminated warm fresh water enters the nose. It can cause rapidly progressive primary amoebic meningoencephalitis with severe headache, fever, vomiting, confusion, seizures, and coma. It is a medical emergency.

### **Nail**

A protective plate of hardened keratin covering the dorsal surface of the distal phalanges of the fingers and toes.

### **Nail Changes**

Alterations in nail color, shape, texture, or attachment that may result from local injury, skin disease, infection, medicines, nutritional deficiency, or systemic illness. Their significance depends on the pattern and other clinical findings.

### **Nail Clubbing**

Abnormal enlargement of the distal digit with increased nail curvature and loss of the normal nail-fold angle. It may be familial or associated with pulmonary, cardiovascular, gastrointestinal, or malignant disease and should be interpreted with the clinical context.

### **Nail Infection**

Infection of the nail or surrounding tissue, commonly caused by fungi or bacteria. It may cause thickening, discoloration, separation of the nail, pain, swelling, or drainage; diabetes and poor circulation increase the risk of complications.

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### **Nail Pits**

Small, sharply circumscribed depressions in the nail plate caused by abnormal focal keratinization of the proximal nail matrix. They are classically associated with psoriasis but may also occur in alopecia areata, eczema, lichen planus, or other nail disorders.

### **Nail Psoriasis**

Nail psoriasis affects 50 percent of patients with psoriasis and 80 percent with nail involvement having joint disease. Features include pitting (most common), onycholysis (nail separation), oil drop sign (salmon patch), subungual hyperkeratosis, and nail plate crumbling. Nail psoriasis is associated with psoriatic arthritis.

### **Nanocolloid**

Tc-99m labeled colloidal particles for lymphatic imaging. Particle size 10-100 nm. Used for sentinel node detection.

### **Narcissistic Personality Disorder**

A pattern of grandiosity, need for admiration, and lack of empathy.

#### **Synonyms:**

NPD (Narcissistic Personality Disorder) Personality Disorder, Narcissistic

### **Narcolepsy**

Narcolepsy is a chronic sleep-wake disorder with excessive daytime sleepiness and, in some people, cataplexy, sleep paralysis, and hypnagogic hallucinations. sleep attacks, with or without cataplexy (sudden bilateral loss of muscle tone triggered by strong emotions). Narcolepsy type 1: with cataplexy, caused by loss of hypocretin/orexin neurons in the hypothalamus.

#### **Synonyms:**

Excessive Daytime Sleepiness Sleepiness, Daytime

### **Narrow Angle Glaucoma**

Anatomical narrowing of the anterior chamber angle due to relative pupillary block or a shallow anterior chamber, creating risk for angle closure and acute intraocular pressure elevation. Identified on gonioscopy, it may be managed with laser peripheral

iridotomy to equalise pressure between the posterior and anterior chambers.

### **Narrow Therapeutic Index**

A drug characteristic where there is a small difference between the therapeutic dose and the toxic dose, requiring careful dosing and therapeutic drug monitoring to ensure efficacy while avoiding toxicity. Narrow therapeutic index drugs have a therapeutic index  $<2$ -3 (the ratio of toxic dose to effective dose).

### **Narrow-Complex Tachycardia**

A rapid cardiac rhythm with QRS complexes of normal or near-normal width, usually arising above the ventricles.

### **Narrowband UVB Phototherapy**

Controlled exposure to ultraviolet B light centered near 311–313 nm for inflammatory or pigmentary skin disease. It is used for psoriasis, vitiligo, eczema, and other selected conditions with eye protection, cumulative-dose monitoring, and skin-cancer risk assessment.

### **Nasal Cannula**

A device with two small prongs placed in the nostrils to deliver supplemental oxygen. The flow rate is adjusted to the patient's needs and the device used.

### **Nasal Congestion And Rhinorrhea**

Nasal obstruction or stuffiness together with a runny nose, commonly caused by viral infection, allergic or nonallergic rhinitis, sinus disease, irritants, or structural blockage. Persistent unilateral symptoms, recurrent bleeding, fever, facial swelling, or breathing difficulty requires evaluation.

### **Neck Mass**

A lump or swelling in the neck caused by an enlarged lymph node, congenital cyst, thyroid or salivary-gland lesion, infection, or tumor. A persistent, enlarging, firm, fixed, or unexplained mass—especially in an adult—requires prompt medical evaluation.

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## Neck And Back Pain

Pain in the cervical, thoracic, or lumbar spine and surrounding tissues, commonly caused by strain, degenerative disease, disc problems, or trauma. Weakness, numbness, gait difficulty, bowel or bladder changes, fever, cancer history, or major trauma requires urgent assessment.

## Nasal Cavity

The paired space inside the nose, extending from the nostrils to the nasopharynx. It warms, humidifies, and filters inspired air and contains the receptors responsible for smell.

## Nasal Congestion

A sensation of nasal stuffiness or obstruction from engorgement of the venous sinusoids within the nasal mucosa, especially the inferior turbinates; a symptom shared by many conditions.

## Nasal Endoscopy

Direct endoscopic inspection of the nasal passages, turbinates, septum, sinus drainage pathways, and nasopharynx. It is useful for chronic rhinosinusitis, unilateral obstruction, epistaxis, polyps, foreign bodies, and suspected neoplasia.

## Nasal Flaring

Widening and outward movement of the nostrils during breathing. It is a visible sign of increased work of breathing, particularly in infants and children, and may accompany airway obstruction, bronchiolitis, pneumonia, asthma, or severe systemic illness.

## Nasal Implant

A device placed in or near the nose to support nasal structures or improve airflow. Its purpose depends on the device and condition.

## Nasal Obstruction

Blocked airflow through one or both nasal passages. Causes include congestion, allergy, infection, a deviated septum, polyps, trauma, or a mass. Persistent one-sided obstruction or bleeding requires medical evaluation.

## Nasal Polyps

Benign, pedunculated, edematous outgrowths of the sinus and nasal mucosa that arise most commonly from the ethmoidal sinuses and protrude into the nasal cavity through the middle meatus, causing nasal obstruction, anosmia (loss of smell), and rhinorrhea.

### Synonyms:

Polyps, Nasal

## Nasal Septal Hematoma

A collection of blood between the nasal septal cartilage and its perichondrium, usually after nasal trauma. It causes nasal obstruction and a soft fluctuant septal swelling and requires urgent drainage to prevent cartilage necrosis and saddle-nose deformity.

## Nasal Septum

The wall that divides the nasal cavity into right and left sides. It consists mainly of cartilage in front and bone behind and helps support the nose and direct airflow.

## Nasal Stent

Support for nasal septum/airway. Materials: silicone, metal. Indications: septal hematoma, post-septoplasty support, nasal valve collapse. Complications: crusting, infection, pressure necrosis.

## Nasogastric Tube

A tube passed through the nose into the stomach to remove contents or deliver nutrition, fluids, or medicines when clinically indicated.

## Nasopharyngeal Airway

A soft tube inserted through the nose to maintain a passage between the nares and pharynx. It may be useful in a spontaneously breathing patient with partial upper-airway obstruction but is relatively contraindicated in suspected basal skull fracture or significant nasal trauma.

## Nasopharyngeal Carcinoma

A malignancy arising from the epithelial lining of



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the nasopharynx, and it has a unique geographical and ethnic distribution, with highest incidence in southern China, Southeast Asia, and North Africa.

**Synonyms:**

Cancer, Nasopharyngeal

**Natal Teeth**

Teeth present at birth, most often involving the lower central incisors. They may be loose, interfere with feeding, or injure the infant's tongue and require dental assessment.

**Natural Killer Cell**

A type of innate lymphoid cell (lymphocyte) that provides early defense against virus-infected cells and tumor cells without prior sensitization. NK cells recognize stressed or missing-self cells (absent or altered MHC class I) and kill them by releasing perforin and granzymes, or through antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity.

**Nausea**

An unpleasant sensation of an impending need to vomit, often accompanied by autonomic symptoms such as salivation, sweating, pallor, or dizziness. Common causes include gastrointestinal illness, pregnancy, medication effects, migraine, vestibular disorders, metabolic disease, and serious abdominal or neurologic conditions.

**Navicular**

Boat-shaped tarsal bone between talus and three cuneiforms. Navicular tuberosity is a palpable medial prominence serving as posterior tibial tendon insertion, key medial longitudinal arch stabilizer. Central third has a precarious blood supply, susceptible to stress fractures and avascular necrosis (Kohler disease in children).

**NDM-1**

New Delhi metallo-beta-lactamase-1, an enzyme that allows certain bacteria to resist many beta-lactam antibiotics, including carbapenems. NDM-1-producing organisms can cause difficult-to-treat urinary, wound, bloodstream, or lung infections. Laboratory susceptibility testing and strict infection-

control measures are essential.

**Nearsightedness**

Nearsightedness, or myopia, occurs when light focuses in front of the retina, causing distant blur that is corrected with lenses, contact lenses, or selected procedures. light focuses in front of the retina. It is corrected with diverging lenses, contact lenses, or refractive surgery.

**Synonyms:**

myopia, in which distant objects appear blurred because.

**Nebulizer**

A device that converts liquid medications into a mist for inhalation. Used for bronchodilators (albuterol, ipratropium) and corticosteroids in acute exacerbations. More effective than MDI in patients with severe obstruction.

**Neck Cancer**

Human papillomavirus, particularly HPV-16, is an increasingly important etiological factor in head and neck squamous cell carcinoma, particularly oropharyngeal cancer, and it is responsible for the rising incidence of oropharyngeal cancer in younger patients without traditional risk factors of tobacco and alcohol use.

**Neck Pain**

Pain or stiffness in the cervical region, commonly caused by muscle strain, degenerative disease, poor posture, or injury. Severe pain after trauma or pain with weakness, numbness, fever, or neurologic deficits requires prompt assessment.

**Synonyms:**

Cervical Pain Cervical Pain (Neck Pain) Pain, Neck

**Necrobiosis Lipoidica**

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder characterized by yellow-brown, atrophic plaques, usually on the shins. It is associated with diabetes but can occur without diabetes.

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### **Necrobiosis Lipoidica Diabeticorum**

Necrobiosis lipoidica diabeticorum is a chronic inflammatory skin disorder causing yellow-brown atrophic plaques, often on the shins and associated with diabetes.

### **Necrolytic Migratory Erythema**

A recurrent, erosive, erythematous eruption that often affects periorificial and intertriginous skin. It is classically associated with glucagonoma but may have other causes, so evaluation should consider nutritional, hepatic, pancreatic, and metabolic disease.

### **Necropsy**

A post-mortem examination of an animal or human body to determine disease or cause of death.

### **Necroptosis**

A regulated, programmed form of necrosis that shares features of both classical necrosis and apoptosis, serving as a backup cell death mechanism when apoptosis is inhibited. It is particularly important during viral infections, as many viruses encode proteins that block caspase-mediated apoptosis to ensure their own replication.

### **Necrosis**

Necrosis is death of cells or tissue within a living body caused by ischemia, infection, toxins, trauma, inflammation, or other injury.

### **Necrotizing Anterior Scleritis**

A severe, sight-threatening form of scleral inflammation characterised by ischaemic necrosis of the sclera with visible underlying uvea through thinned, grey-white scleral patches.

### **Necrotizing Enterocolitis**

An acquired inflammatory disease that can cause intestinal necrosis, primarily affecting premature infants. Risk factors include prematurity, enteral feeding, and bacterial colonization. It may cause abdominal distension, bloody stools, bilious vomiting, and feeding intolerance. Pneumatosis intestinalis on imaging strongly supports the diagnosis but must

be interpreted with the clinical findings.

### **Necrotizing Fasciitis**

A life-threatening soft tissue infection characterized by rapid necrosis of the subcutaneous fascia and subcutaneous tissue, with relative sparing of the overlying skin in early stages. It is a surgical emergency requiring immediate wide surgical debridement and broad-spectrum antibiotics.

### **Necrotizing Soft Tissue Infection**

A rapidly progressive infection of fascia, subcutaneous tissue, or muscle causing severe pain, swelling, systemic toxicity, and tissue necrosis. It is a surgical emergency requiring immediate assessment, broad antimicrobial therapy, and aggressive debridement.

### **Necrotizing Infections**

Severe infections that cause tissue death through microbial invasion, toxin production, thrombosis, or intense inflammation. Examples include necrotizing fasciitis, necrotizing pneumonia, and necrotizing enterocolitis; rapidly progressive pain, swelling, skin changes, systemic toxicity, or organ dysfunction requires emergency evaluation and source control.

### **Needle**

Hollow metal tube for fluid withdrawal or injection. Gauge: larger number = smaller diameter. Common gauges: 18G (blood draw), 22G (IV), 25-27G (injection).

### **Needle Driver**

Instrument for passing suture needle through tissue.

### **Needle Driver (Perineal)**

A hand instrument used to hold and guide a suture needle during a perineal repair.

**Synonyms:**

Perineal

### **Needle Driver (Vascular)**

A hand instrument used to hold and guide a suture needle during vascular repair.

**Synonyms:**

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Vascular

### **Needle Holder**

A surgical instrument with jaws used to grasp and guide a suture needle during tissue repair.

### **Negative Feedback**

A regulatory mechanism in which the output of a system feeds back to decrease or reverse the initiating stimulus, maintaining homeostasis around a set point.

### **Negative Predictive Value**

The probability that a person with a negative test result truly does not have the target condition. NPV varies with disease prevalence or pretest probability and is not an intrinsic fixed property of a test.

### **Negative Pressure Ventilation**

Ventilation using negative pressure applied around the chest wall to expand the lungs, as opposed to positive pressure applied to the airway. The “iron lung” is a historical example. Modern negative pressure ventilators include the cuirass and wrap. They are rarely used today but may be useful in neuromuscular disease.

### **Negative Symptoms**

Reduced or absent normal emotional, motivational, cognitive, or social functions, including affective flattening, alogia, avolition, anhedonia, and asociality. Persistent negative symptoms can substantially impair functional recovery.

### **Neglect**

A form of child maltreatment: the failure to provide for a child’s basic needs—physical (food, clothing, shelter, medical care), educational, or emotional—causing harm or risk of harm. Features: failure to thrive, poor hygiene, untreated illness/injury, missed healthcare appointments, inadequate supervision, and developmental delay.

### **Neglect Syndrome**

Hemispatial neglect (unilateral neglect, hemineglect)

is a neurological condition characterized by failure to attend to, respond to, or orient toward stimuli on the side of space contralateral to the brain lesion, in the absence of primary sensory or motor deficits sufficient to explain the neglect.

### **Neisseria Gonorrhoeae**

A gram-negative diplococcus that causes gonorrhea, a sexually transmitted infection. The organism has developed resistance to many antibiotics including fluoroquinolones and macrolides.

### **Neisseria Meningitidis**

A gram-negative diplococcus that causes meningitis and meningococemia. The organism has a polysaccharide capsule that is the target of conjugate vaccines. Serogroups A, B, C, W, X, and Y cause most disease. Meningitis presents with fever, headache, neck stiffness, and altered mental status.

### **Nelson Syndrome**

Enlargement and hypersecretion of an adrenocorticotrophic-hormone-producing pituitary tumour after bilateral adrenalectomy, usually for Cushing disease. It may cause rapid skin hyperpigmentation, headache, visual-field loss, and other effects of an expanding sellar mass.

### **Neoadjuvant Therapy**

Treatment before primary treatment to shrink tumor. Examples: chemotherapy before surgery.

### **Neonatal Abstinence Syndrome**

A withdrawal syndrome in neonates following in utero exposure to opioids (most common) or other substances (benzodiazepines, SSRIs, alcohol). Onset within 24-72 hours of birth (varies by half-life of substance).

### **Neonatal Cephalohematoma**

A collection of blood beneath the periosteum of a newborn’s skull, usually caused by birth trauma. It is limited by skull sutures and generally resolves over time, although it requires assessment for associated injury or jaundice.

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### Neonatal Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the conjunctiva during the first month of life, caused by chemical irritation, bacteria, or viruses acquired during delivery. Purulent discharge, eyelid swelling, and corneal involvement require urgent evaluation.

### Neonatal Diabetes Mellitus

Diabetes diagnosed within the first six months of life. Can be transient or permanent. Transient neonatal diabetes mellitus is caused by abnormalities at chromosome 6q24 and usually resolves but may relapse in adolescence.

### Neonatal Herpes Simplex

Herpes simplex virus infection in the first 28 days of life, usually HSV-2 from maternal genital infection. Three forms: skin, eye, and mouth disease; CNS disease; and disseminated disease. Disseminated form mimics sepsis with high mortality. Diagnosis by viral PCR, culture, or Tzanck smear. Treatment: IV acyclovir for 14-21 days.

### Neonatal Herpes Simplex Virus

A severe neonatal infection caused by herpes simplex virus, typically acquired during passage through the birth canal, presenting within the first month of life as skin, eye, and mouth disease, central nervous system disease, or disseminated disease with multiorgan involvement.

### Neonatal Hyperbilirubinemia

Elevated unconjugated bilirubin levels in newborns exceeding 5 mg per deciliter, potentially causing jaundice and, if severe, kernicterus with neurological damage. Phototherapy is the standard treatment.

### Neonatal Hypoglycemia

Blood glucose less than 40-45 mg/dL in term infants or less than 25 mg/dL in preterm infants. Risk factors include prematurity, small for gestational age, large for gestational age, and maternal diabetes. Presents with jitteriness, lethargy, poor feeding, and seizures. Treatment: early feeding, IV dextrose infusion, and monitoring.

### Neonatal Hypocalcemia

Low serum calcium in a newborn, which may cause jitteriness, poor feeding, hypotonia, apnea, or seizures. Causes include prematurity, maternal diabetes, birth asphyxia, and disorders of parathyroid function.

### Neonatal Hypothermia

Core body temperature below 36.5 degrees Celsius in a newborn. Classified as mild (36-36.4), moderate (32-35.9), or severe (below 32). Occurs due to rapid heat loss through evaporation, convection, conduction, and radiation. Prevention: skin-to-skin contact, drying, warm environment, and delayed bathing.

### Neonatal Polycythemia

An abnormally high red-cell concentration in a newborn, often defined by a venous hematocrit of at least 65 percent. It may increase blood viscosity and cause respiratory, neurologic, or metabolic symptoms.

### Neonatal Hypoxic-Ischemic Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction in a newborn caused by inadequate oxygenation and/or cerebral blood flow around the time of birth. Moderate or severe HIE may produce altered consciousness, abnormal tone, seizures, and multiorgan injury; selected term or near-term infants may benefit from early therapeutic hypothermia.

### Neonatal Infections

Early-onset sepsis (EOS, <72h): GBS, *E. coli*, *Listeria*. Risk factors: maternal GBS+, chorioamnionitis, PROM >18h. Kaiser sepsis calculator for management. Late-onset sepsis (LOS, >72h): CoNS, *S.*

### Neonatal Jaundice

Yellow discoloration of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by elevated bilirubin. It is common but may require treatment or investigation when severe, early, or prolonged.

#### Synonyms:

Newborn Jaundice (Neonatal Jaundice)

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### Neonatal Jaundice (Jaundice Of The Newborn)

Yellow discoloration of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by elevated bilirubin. It is often physiologic but requires assessment when severe, early, rapidly increasing, or prolonged.

#### Synonyms:

Jaundice of the Newborn

### Neonatal Resuscitation

The systematic approach to stabilizing a newborn after delivery, guided by the Neonatal Resuscitation Program (NRP).

### Neonatal Sepsis

Systemic bacterial infection in the first 28 days of life, classified as early-onset (within 72 hours, usually from vertical transmission) or late-onset (after 72 hours, often nosocomial). Common organisms: Group B Streptococcus, E. coli, Listeria.

### Neonatal Skin Conditions

Common and usually benign. Erythema toxicum neonatorum (red papules and pustules on erythematous base, appears day 2 to 3, resolves by 2 weeks). Milia (tiny white cysts on nose and cheeks). Miliaria crystallina (clear vesicles from sweat duct obstruction). Sebaceous hyperplasia (yellow papules on nose and cheeks).

### Neonatal Thyrotoxicosis

Transient hyperthyroidism in newborns caused by transplacental transfer of maternal thyroid-stimulating immunoglobulins, presenting with tachycardia, irritability, and poor weight gain in the first weeks of life.

### Neonatal Transition

The physiologic adaptation from placental gas exchange to pulmonary respiration after birth. It includes lung aeration, falling pulmonary vascular resistance, closure of fetal circulatory shunts, and changes in cardiac output and thermoregulation.

### Neonatologist

A pediatrician who specializes in the medical care of newborn infants, particularly premature and critically ill neonates.

### Neoplasm

Abnormal growth of tissue, may be benign or malignant. Benign neoplasms: localized, slow-growing, do not metastasize. Malignant neoplasms (cancer): invasive, metastasize, can be fatal. Classification: carcinoma (epithelial origin), sarcoma (mesenchymal origin), leukemia (hematopoietic), lymphoma (lymphoid).

### Nephrectomy

Surgical removal of a kidney. Radical nephrectomy: kidney + Gerota fascia + adrenal gland (for renal cell carcinoma). Partial nephrectomy (nephron-sparing): for small renal tumors (<7 cm, renal function preservation). Simple nephrectomy: for benign disease (non-functioning kidney, chronic infection, massive hydronephrosis).

### Nephritic Syndrome

Characterized by hematuria with dysmorphic RBCs and RBC casts, oliguria, hypertension, and mild proteinuria less than 3.5 g/day. Results from glomerular inflammation increasing permeability to cells and reducing GFR. Hypertension from sodium and water retention.

### Nephroblastoma

Wilms tumor, a malignant embryonal renal tumor of childhood that commonly presents as an asymptomatic abdominal mass.

### Nephrocalcinosis

Nephrocalcinosis is deposition of calcium salts within kidney tissue, caused by metabolic, hormonal, genetic, medication-related, or renal disorders.

### Nephrogenic Diabetes Insipidus

Inability of the renal collecting ducts to respond adequately to antidiuretic hormone, causing excessive dilute urine production and intense thirst. Causes include inherited defects, chronic kidney disease,



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electrolyte disorders, and medication exposure.

### **Nephrogenic Fibrosing Dermopathy**

A rare fibrosing disorder of the skin causing thickening and hardening, primarily of the extremities and trunk, associated with kidney failure and gadolinium-based contrast exposure.

### **Nephrogenic Systemic Fibrosis**

A rare fibrosing disorder associated mainly with exposure to certain gadolinium contrast agents in people with severe kidney impairment.

### **Nephrolithiasis**

Formation of stones in the urinary tract. Calcium-containing stones are common, but stone composition varies and may include uric acid, struvite, or cystine. Risk factors include dehydration, hypercalciuria, hyperoxaluria, hypocitraturia, and low urine volume. Evaluation includes 24-hour urine analysis.

### **Nephron**

Functional unit of the kidney comprising the glomerulus, proximal tubule, loop of Henle, distal tubule, and collecting duct. Each kidney contains approximately one million nephrons responsible for filtering blood, reabsorbing solutes and water, and excreting waste to form urine.

### **Nephron Function**

The nephron is the functional unit of the kidney, with approximately 1 million per kidney. Each nephron consists of a renal corpuscle (glomerulus and Bowman's capsule) and a renal tubule (proximal convoluted tubule, loop of Henle, distal convoluted tubule, and collecting duct).

### **Nephronophthisis**

An autosomal-recessive tubulointerstitial kidney disease causing progressive loss of concentrating ability, polyuria, polydipsia, anemia, and chronic kidney failure. It may be isolated or part of a ciliopathy with retinal, skeletal, hepatic, or neurological manifestations.

### **Nephropathy**

Disease or damage of the kidneys, which may impair filtration, fluid balance, or other kidney functions.

### **Nephrostomy**

An artificial opening created between the kidney and the skin to drain urine directly when the normal pathway is blocked. See urology.

### **Nephrostomy Tube**

A percutaneously placed catheter in the renal pelvis to drain urine, bypassing a ureteral obstruction. Indications: ureteral obstruction (calculus, tumor, stricture) causing hydronephrosis, pyonephrosis (infected, obstructed kidney — emergency drainage), and as a temporary measure before definitive surgery.

### **Nephrotic Range Proteinuria**

Protein excretion greater than 3.5 g/day or urine protein-to-creatinine ratio greater than 3.5 g/g. Reflects severe glomerular damage with significant protein loss. Degree correlates with severity of injury and risk of complications including thromboembolism, infection, and progression to ESRD.

### **Nephrotic Syndrome**

Clinical constellation of heavy proteinuria greater than 3.5 g/day, hypoalbuminemia less than 3.0 g/dL, generalized edema, hyperlipidemia, and lipiduria. Results from increased glomerular permeability to albumin. Reduced oncotic pressure causes fluid extravasation. Hepatic lipoprotein synthesis increases causing hyperlipidemia.

### **Nephrotoxicity**

Kidney damage from toxins, drugs, contrast. Aminoglycosides, cisplatin, contrast media, ethylene glycol. Monitoring: creatinine, urine output. Prevention: hydration, dose adjustment.

### **Nerve**

A bundle of axons (nerve fibers) surrounded by connective tissue sheaths that transmits electrical impulses between the central nervous system and the periphery. Structure: epineurium (outer layer), per-



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ineurium (surrounds fascicles), endoneurium (surrounds individual axons).

### **Nerve Conduction Studies**

Measurement of the speed and amplitude of electrical impulses along peripheral nerves. Sensory NCS: stimulate at one point, record distally. Motor NCS: stimulate at two or more points along the nerve, record from muscle. Parameters: conduction velocity (m/s), amplitude (microvolts/millivolts), and distal latency.

### **Nerve Conduction Study**

A diagnostic test that measures the speed and strength of electrical signals traveling through a nerve to detect nerve damage or dysfunction.

### **Nervous Tissue**

The tissue of the nervous system, composed of neurons and supporting cells, that detects stimuli and transmits electrical signals.

### **Nettle Rash**

Urticaria, an itchy eruption of transient raised wheals caused by release of inflammatory mediators in the skin.

### **Neural Tube Defects**

Congenital malformations resulting from failure of the neural tube to close during the third to fourth week of gestation. Include anencephaly (incomplete cranial closure), encephalocele (herniation through skull defect), and spina bifida (incomplete spinal closure).

### **Neuralgia**

Neuralgia is sharp, burning, or electric pain along the distribution of a nerve, caused by irritation, compression, infection, injury, or other disease.

### **Neuraminidase Inhibitors**

A class of antiviral drugs that inhibit the neuraminidase enzyme on the surface of influenza viruses, preventing the release of newly formed viral particles from infected cells and thereby limiting vi-

ral spread. The two available agents are oseltamivir, administered orally, and zanamivir, administered by inhalation.

### **Neuroblastoma**

Neuroblastoma is a childhood cancer of immature sympathetic nervous-system cells, commonly arising in the adrenal or paraspinal region and ranging from spontaneously resolving to aggressive disease. as abdominal mass, opsoclonus-myoclonus syndrome. Spontaneous regression possible in infants.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Neuroblastoma

### **Neurocognitive Disorder**

A condition involving acquired decline in one or more cognitive abilities that affects daily function. Causes include neurodegenerative disease, vascular disease, injury, infection, and medicines.

### **Neurocysticercosis**

The most common parasitic infection of the central nervous system worldwide and is caused by the larval stage (cysticercus) of the pork tapeworm *Taenia solium*. It is endemic in Latin America, Asia, and Africa, and is an important cause of epilepsy in endemic regions.

### **Neurodegeneration**

The progressive loss of structure and function of neurons, culminating in their death, and represents the underlying mechanism of many devastating neurological disorders.

### **Neuroendocrine Tumor**

A tumor arising from cells with both neural and hormone-producing features. These tumors can occur throughout the body and may produce hormones or be nonfunctioning.

### **Neuroendocrine Tumors Grading**

Classification of neuroendocrine tumors by proliferative rate using Ki-67 index and mitotic count. Well-differentiated low-grade tumors have Ki-67 less than three percent and fewer than two mitoses per ten high-power fields. Intermediate-grade tumors

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have Ki-67 of three to twenty percent.

### **Neurofibroma**

A benign peripheral nerve sheath tumor. Solitary neurofibromas are common and present as soft, flesh-colored papules or nodules. Multiple neurofibromas are characteristic of neurofibromatosis type 1 (NF1).

### **Neurofibromatosis**

A group of autosomal dominant genetic disorders causing tumor growth along nerves. Type 1 (NF1, chromosome 17) causes café-au-lait spots, neurofibromas, optic gliomas, and learning disabilities. Type 2 (NF2, chromosome 22) causes bilateral vestibular schwannomas, meningiomas, and ependymomas.

### **Neurofibromatosis Type 1**

Autosomal dominant disorder caused by mutations in the NF1 gene encoding neurofibromin on chromosome seventeen.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neurofibromatosis Type I NF1 Peripheral Neurofibromatosis Von Recklinghausen's Disease Von Recklinghausen's Neurofibromatosis Von Recklinghausen's Phakomatosis

### **Neurofibromatosis Type 2**

An autosomal dominant disorder caused by NF2 gene mutation on chromosome 22. Characterized by bilateral vestibular schwannomas (acoustic neuromas), meningiomas, and ependymomas. Features: hearing loss, tinnitus, and balance problems. Diagnosis: MRI showing bilateral vestibular schwannomas.

### **Neurogenic Bladder**

Lower urinary-tract dysfunction caused by a neurologic lesion affecting central or peripheral control of storage and voiding. It may produce urgency, retention, incontinence, high bladder pressures, recurrent infection, and upper-tract damage.

### **Neurogenic Megacolon**

Massive dilation of the colon due to loss of autonomic innervation, most commonly from Chagas

disease, Hirschsprung disease, or diabetic autonomic neuropathy. It presents with chronic constipation, abdominal distension, fecal impaction, and risk of toxic megacolon.

### **Neurogenic Shock**

Distributive shock caused by loss of sympathetic vascular tone, usually after acute spinal-cord injury above T6. It is characterized by hypotension with relative bradycardia and warm skin, distinguishing it from hemorrhagic shock when the clinical findings are complete.

### **Neurography**

MRI technique visualizing peripheral nerves. Used for nerve tumors, entrapment, trauma.

### **Neuroleptic**

An older term for antipsychotic medications, derived from their ability to produce a state of mental indifference and motor slowing. The term is now largely replaced by "antipsychotic," though it is still used in specific contexts such as neuroleptic malignant syndrome. Typical neuroleptics are first-generation antipsychotics.

### **Neuroleptic Malignant Syndrome**

A rare but life-threatening idiosyncratic reaction to dopamine receptor-blocking agents, typically antipsychotics, characterized by hyperthermia, severe muscle rigidity, altered mental status, and autonomic dysfunction.

### **Neurologic Localization**

The process of using the pattern of deficits in strength, sensation, reflexes, coordination, cranial-nerve function, and cognition to identify the anatomic site of nervous-system dysfunction. Localization guides differential diagnosis and selection of investigations.

### **Neurological Examination**

A clinical assessment of mental status, cranial nerves, motor function, reflexes, coordination, sensation, and gait. It helps localize nervous-system dysfunction and determine the need for further test-

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ing.

### Neurological Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation for stroke, spinal cord injury, traumatic brain injury, Parkinson disease, multiple sclerosis. Goals: maximize function, independence, quality of life. Multidisciplinary team: physiatrist, PT, OT, speech therapy, psychology.

### Neurology PET

PET imaging used in selected neurologic disorders to assess brain metabolism or receptor activity, such as in some dementias, epilepsy evaluations, and movement disorders.

### Neuromuscular Blocking Agents

Medications administered intraoperatively to induce skeletal muscle relaxation and facilitate endotracheal intubation and surgical exposure.

### Neuromuscular Junction

The neuromuscular junction is the synapse between motor neuron and skeletal muscle fiber, where acetylcholine released from presynaptic terminals binds to nicotinic acetylcholine receptors on the postsynaptic motor end plate, causing depolarization and muscle contraction.

### Neuromyelitis Optica

Neuromyelitis optica spectrum disorder (NMOSD), formerly known as Devic disease, is an autoimmune, inflammatory demyelinating disorder of the central nervous system that preferentially targets the optic nerves and spinal cord.

#### Synonyms:

Devic's Disease NMO NMOSD

### Neuron

The fundamental excitable cell of the nervous system specialized for receiving, integrating, and transmitting electrical and chemical signals. Structural components: cell body (soma), dendrites (receptive), axon (conducting), and synaptic terminals (releasing neurotransmitters).

### Neuropathic Pain

Chronic pain caused by damage or disease affecting the somatosensory nervous system, including the peripheral nerves, dorsal root ganglia, spinal cord, or brain.

### Neuropathic Ulcer

A chronic wound of the foot in a patient with diabetes, resulting from peripheral neuropathy, peripheral artery disease, and impaired wound healing. See diabetic foot ulcer.

### Neuropathy

Disease or dysfunction of peripheral nerves causing pain, numbness, tingling, weakness, or altered reflexes. Common causes include diabetes, alcohol, nutritional deficiency, toxins, compression, autoimmune disease, and inherited disorders.

### Neuropathy (Peripheral Neuropathy)

Damage to peripheral nerves causing sensory, motor, or autonomic dysfunction. Common causes: diabetes mellitus, alcohol use disorder, vitamin B12 deficiency, chemotherapy, autoimmune diseases, and hereditary conditions (Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease). Presents with numbness, tingling, burning pain, weakness, and gait instability.

#### Synonyms:

Peripheral Neuropathy

### Neuroplasticity

The brain's ability to reorganize its structure, function, and connections in response to experience, learning, and injury. It is relevant to psychiatric treatment because antidepressants, psychotherapy, and ECT are thought to promote neuroplastic changes including neurogenesis in the hippocampus and synaptic remodeling.

### Neurosarcoidosis

Neurosarcoidosis is sarcoid inflammation affecting the nervous system, potentially involving cranial nerves, meninges, brain, spinal cord, or peripheral nerves.

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## Neurosyphilis

Neurosyphilis is infection of the nervous system by *Treponema pallidum* and can cause meningitis, stroke, sensory loss, cognitive change, or tabes dorsalis.

## Neurotransmitter

Neurotransmitters are endogenous chemical messengers that transmit signals across synapses from one neuron to another or to target cells such as muscle or gland cells.

## Neurovascular Examination

Assessment of distal motor function, sensation, pulses, capillary refill, skin temperature, and color in an injured limb. Serial examination is essential for detecting nerve injury, vascular compromise, compartment syndrome, and evolving ischemia.

## Neutropenia

A reduced neutrophil count ( $< 1.5 \times 10^9/L$ ; severe  $< 0.5$ ), increasing risk of bacterial and fungal infection, especially febrile neutropenia.

### Synonyms:

Low Neutrophil Count (Neutropenia)

## Neutrophil Extracellular Traps

NETs: web-like structures of chromatin + granular proteins (MPO, NE, histone) released by neutrophils (NETosis: suicidal vs vital).

## Neutrophil Recruitment

A multistep process essential for acute inflammation and host defense, involving sequential adhesive interactions between neutrophils and endothelial cells. The process begins with the rolling phase, where neutrophils loosely attach to endothelial cells through selectin-mediated interactions.

## Neutrophilic Dermatitis

A group of inflammatory skin conditions characterised by dense neutrophilic infiltrate in the dermis without evidence of infection, which includes Sweet syndrome (acute febrile neutrophilic dermatosis), pyoderma gangrenosum, and Behçet disease.

## Neutrophilic Eccrine Hidradenitis

A neutrophilic dermatosis characterized by neutrophilic infiltration of the eccrine glands and surrounding dermis, typically occurring in patients receiving chemotherapy, particularly cytarabine. It presents with painful, erythematous plaques or nodules, most commonly on the trunk and extremities.

## Nevus

A benign hamartoma of the skin; most commonly melanocytic nevus (mole). Other nevi: congenital, dysplastic/atypical, Spitz, blue nevus, halo nevus; non-melanocytic: epidermal, sebaceous, vascular (strawberry hemangioma, port-wine stain).

## Nevus Comedonicus

A congenital hamartoma of the pilosebaceous unit presenting as a localised cluster of dilated follicular ostia filled with keratinous plugs, resembling closely grouped open comedones. It typically appears at birth or in early childhood on the face, neck, or trunk, and may be associated with other developmental anomalies.

## New Daily Persistent Headache

A headache that begins on a clearly remembered day and becomes continuous within 24 hours, persisting for at least three months. It may resemble migraine or tension-type headache; a new persistent headache requires medical evaluation to exclude secondary causes such as infection, pressure disorders, or vascular disease.

## Newborn Circumcision

Surgical removal of the foreskin from the penis, typically performed within the first few days of life. Medical benefits include reduced risk of urinary tract infections, sexually transmitted infections, and penile cancer. Complications include bleeding, infection, and meatal stenosis.

## Newborn Hearing Screen

Universal screening for congenital hearing loss, performed before hospital discharge. Two-step protocol: otoacoustic emissions (OAE: measures cochlear outer hair cell response to click stimulus) and auto-

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mated auditory brainstem response (AABR: measures neural response from the cochlea to the brainstem). Pass/refer.

### **Newborn Metabolic Screen**

A dried blood spot test (heel stick) collected 24-48 hours after birth to screen for congenital disorders before symptoms develop.

### **Newborn Screening**

A public health program testing newborns for treatable genetic, metabolic, and endocrine disorders 24-48 hours after birth. Blood spot (heel stick) on filter paper (Guthrie card). Conditions vary by state (Recommended Uniform Screening Panel: 35 core conditions).

### **Next-Generation Sequencing**

Massively parallel sequencing technology that analyzes many DNA molecules simultaneously. It supports gene panels, whole-exome sequencing, whole-genome sequencing, and tumor sequencing, with limitations involving coverage, structural variants, mosaicism, and interpretation.

### **Niacin (Vitamin B3)**

A water-soluble vitamin that forms NAD<sup>+</sup> and NADP<sup>+</sup>, essential electron carriers in oxidation-reduction reactions and biosynthetic pathways. Severe deficiency causes pellagra, characterized by dermatitis, diarrhea, and dementia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vitamin B3

### **Nickel-Chromium**

Base metal alloy for crowns. Less expensive than noble metals. Nickel allergy concern.

### **Nicotine**

An addictive stimulant found in tobacco and some vaping products that acts on neuronal nicotinic receptors.

### **Niemann-Pick Disease**

A group of autosomal recessive lysosomal storage dis-

orders caused by sphingomyelinase deficiency (ASM, types A and B, SMPD1 mutations) or NPC1/NPC2 cholesterol transport defects (type C).

### **Night Blindness**

Impaired vision in dim light (nyctalopia). Causes: vitamin A deficiency (most common cause worldwide, leading to retinol deficiency and rod dysfunction), retinitis pigmentosa (progressive rod-cone degeneration, genetic), congenital stationary night blindness, advanced glaucoma, and cataract.

### **Night Eating Syndrome**

Delayed circadian pattern of eating. Evening hyperphagia, morning anorexia, insomnia. Associated with obesity, depression.

### **Night Sweats**

Episodes of excessive sweating during sleep that soak clothing or bedding. They may occur with infection, hormonal changes, cancer, medication effects, or other systemic illness; persistent unexplained night sweats warrant assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Children Night Sweats (Night Sweats) Men Night Sweats (Night Sweats)

### **NIH Stroke Scale**

The National Institutes of Health Stroke Scale (NIHSS) is a standardized, validated clinical assessment tool used to quantify the severity of acute ischemic stroke.

### **Nikolsky Sign**

A clinical dermatological sign in which light lateral pressure applied to normal-appearing skin causes epidermal detachment or sloughing. Positive sign indicates intraepidermal loss of cell-cell cohesion (acantholysis).

### **Nipah Virus Infection**

A zoonotic viral infection that may cause fever, respiratory illness, encephalitis, seizures, and coma. It can spread from infected animals or people through close contact. There is no widely available licensed vaccine or specific antiviral treatment; suspected in-



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fection requires urgent isolation and specialist care.

### Nitrates

Vasodilator drugs that release nitric oxide, causing relaxation of vascular smooth muscle through activation of guanylyl cyclase and increased cyclic GMP. They primarily cause venodilation at low doses, reducing preload and myocardial oxygen demand, and arterial dilation at higher doses, reducing afterload.

### Nitrogen Balance

The difference between dietary nitrogen intake, estimated mainly from protein intake, and nitrogen loss, primarily in urine. Positive balance supports growth or tissue repair; negative balance occurs with inadequate intake, inflammation, trauma, or catabolic disease.

### Nitrous Oxide

An inhaled anesthetic gas with analgesic and anesthetic-sparing properties. It has rapid onset and offset but relatively low potency, expands closed gas spaces, and may contribute to diffusion hypoxia or postoperative nausea.

### Nitrous Oxide For Labor

A 50:50 mixture of nitrous oxide and oxygen (Entonox) inhaled by the mother during labor for analgesia. Self-administered via a mask or mouthpiece; the woman controls her own dosing, taking a breath 30 seconds before a contraction.

### Nocardia Asteroides Infection

Infection by *Nocardia asteroides*, an environmental bacterium that can cause lung, skin, or brain infection, especially in immunocompromised people.

### Nocardiosis

A bacterial infection caused by *Nocardia* species (*N. asteroides*, *N. brasiliensis*), found in soil. Most common in immunocompromised patients (transplant, HIV, chronic steroid use). Pulmonary nocardiosis (most common): cough, fever, necrotizing pneumonia, cavitory lesions.

### Nocebo

A harmful or unpleasant symptom or treatment effect caused or amplified by negative expectations rather than by the treatment's specific pharmacologic action.

### Nociception

Neural processing of noxious thermal, mechanical, or chemical stimuli that may result in the perception of pain. It includes transduction, transmission, modulation, and projection; nociception and pain are related but not identical concepts.

### Nocturia

Complaint of waking one or more times during the night to void, with each void preceded and followed by sleep. Highly prevalent in older adults and significantly impairs sleep quality and quality of life.

### Nodular Lymphoid Hyperplasia

Benign aggregates of lymphoid tissue occurring in the gastrointestinal tract, most commonly in the small intestine, presenting as multiple small nodules on endoscopy or imaging. It may be associated with immunodeficiency states, particularly common variable immunodeficiency, and *Giardia lamblia* infection.

### Nodule

Small, palpable mass <2 cm. Can be solid or cystic. Examples: thyroid nodule, rheumatoid nodule, pulmonary nodule. Evaluation depends on location.

### Nomogram

A graphical tool that estimates a quantity or risk from related measurements. The Rumack–Matthew nomogram is used in selected cases of acute acetaminophen ingestion.

### Non Communicating Hydrocephalus

Non-communicating (obstructive) hydrocephalus is a type of hydrocephalus in which there is obstruction to the flow of cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) within the ventricular system, preventing CSF from reaching the arachnoid granulations for absorption.



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### Non-Accidental Trauma

Injuries inflicted on a child, suspected when history and examination findings are inconsistent with the reported mechanism. Red flags: multiple fractures at different stages of healing, posterior rib fractures, metaphyseal corner fractures, and retinal hemorrhages.

### Non-Adherence

Failure to follow an agreed treatment plan, which may result from access barriers, side effects, beliefs, misunderstanding, or other circumstances.

### Non-Alcoholic Fatty Liver Disease

Hepatic steatosis in the absence of significant alcohol consumption, strongly associated with metabolic syndrome, obesity, and type 2 diabetes. NAFLD includes simple steatosis and non-alcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH) with inflammation and fibrosis. NASH can progress to cirrhosis and hepatocellular carcinoma.

### Non-Allergic Rhinitis

Nasal congestion, discharge, or sneezing not caused by an allergic immune response. Triggers may include changes in temperature or humidity, smoke, odors, medicines, or hormonal changes.

### Non-Asthmatic Eosinophilic Bronchitis

A cause of chronic cough characterized by airway eosinophilia without the variable airflow obstruction or bronchial hyperresponsiveness typical of asthma. Symptoms often improve with inhaled corticosteroids, whereas bronchodilators alone may provide little benefit.

### Non-Celiac Gluten Sensitivity

Symptom improvement with gluten-free diet without celiac disease or wheat allergy. Diagnosis of exclusion.

### Non-Communicable Disease

Disease not transmitted between persons. Examples: cancer, heart disease, diabetes.

### Non-Contact Tonometry

A method of estimating intraocular pressure with a brief puff of air directed at the cornea. It does not touch the eye and is useful for screening, although abnormal or uncertain results may require confirmation with another method.

### Non-Distensible Balloon (Vascular)

A catheter balloon designed to maintain its shape during high-pressure dilation of a narrowed vessel.

#### Synonyms:

Vascular

### Non-Functioning Pituitary Adenoma

Pituitary adenomas that do not secrete clinically significant hormones. The most common pituitary adenomas to present with mass effects.

### Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma

A group of malignant lymphoid tumors arising from B cells, T cells, or natural-killer cells. Subtypes differ in biology, clinical behavior, affected organs, and treatment.

#### Synonyms:

Cancer, Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma Lymphoma, Non-Hodgkin

### Non-Invasive Prenatal Testing

Screening of cell-free placental DNA in maternal blood for selected fetal chromosomal abnormalities, especially trisomies 21, 18, and 13. It is highly sensitive screening, not a definitive diagnosis; positive results require confirmatory invasive testing.

### Non-Invasive Ventilation

Positive pressure ventilation delivered via a face mask or nasal mask without endotracheal intubation. BiPAP (bilevel positive airway pressure) is most commonly used for acute hypercapnic respiratory failure (COPD exacerbation) and cardiogenic pulmonary edema. It reduces the need for intubation and improves outcomes in selected patients.

### Non-Proliferative Diabetic Retinopathy

The early stage of diabetic retinopathy, character-

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ized by structural abnormalities of the retinal vasculature resulting from chronic hyperglycemia-induced damage to the endothelial cells and pericytes of retinal capillaries, without neovascularization.

### **Non-Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis**

Inflammatory arthritis affecting the spine and sacroiliac region without definite structural changes on plain X-ray. It may cause chronic inflammatory back pain, morning stiffness, enthesitis, uveitis, psoriasis, or inflammatory bowel disease. MRI, laboratory findings, and clinical assessment help establish the diagnosis.

### **Non-Rebreather Mask**

A face mask with a reservoir bag and one-way valves that can deliver a high concentration of supplemental oxygen when fitted and used correctly.

### **Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer**

Most common lung cancer type. Includes adenocarcinoma, squamous cell, large cell.

### **Non-Stress Test**

Antepartum fetal monitoring assessing fetal heart rate reactivity. Reactive NST:  $\geq 2$  accelerations of 15 bpm for 15 seconds ( $\geq 32$  weeks) or 10 bpm for 10 seconds ( $<32$  weeks) within 20 minutes. Non-reactive: insufficient accelerations after 40 minutes (may indicate fetal sleep, acidosis, or CNS depression). False positive rate high.

### **Non-Tuberculous Mycobacteria**

NTM: environmental mycobacteria (*M. avium* complex - MAC, *M. kansasii*, *M. abscessus*). Pulmonary NTM: ATS/IDSA criteria (clinical + radiographic + microbiologic: 2+ sputum or 1 BAL + nodules/cavities/bronchiectasis on CT).

### **Nonalcoholic Fatty Liver Disease**

NAFLD: hepatic steatosis ( $>5$  percent of hepatocytes) in the absence of significant alcohol use, associated with the metabolic syndrome (obesity, type 2 diabetes, dyslipidemia, hypertension).

### **Nonalcoholic Steatohepatitis**

Progressive form of NAFLD characterized by hepatic steatosis with lobular inflammation and hepatocyte ballooning with significant risk of progression to fibrosis, cirrhosis, and hepatocellular carcinoma. NASH affects approximately three to five percent of the general population.

### **Noncompetitive Antagonist**

A noncompetitive antagonist is a drug that reduces the effect of an agonist by a mechanism that cannot be overcome by increasing the agonist concentration.

### **Noncompetitive Inhibition**

A type of enzyme inhibition where the inhibitor binds at a site distinct from the active site (allosteric site), and can bind to both the free enzyme (E) and the enzyme-substrate complex (ES) with equal affinity. The inhibitor does not compete with the substrate and cannot be overcome by increasing substrate concentration.

### **Noninvasive Prenatal Testing**

A maternal blood test that analyzes cell-free DNA to estimate the chance of selected fetal chromosomal conditions. It is a screening test, not a definitive diagnosis.

### **Noninvasive Ventilation**

Positive-pressure ventilatory support delivered without an endotracheal tube, commonly by a mask or helmet. CPAP provides continuous positive pressure; bilevel support provides separate inspiratory and expiratory pressures. It is used selectively when the patient can protect the airway and cooperate.

### **Nonmelanoma Skin Cancer**

A group of skin cancers that arise from the cells of the epidermis, excluding melanoma. The two most common types are basal cell carcinoma (BCC) and squamous cell carcinoma (SCC), which together account for the vast majority of all skin cancers diagnosed globally.

### **Nonselective Beta-Blockers**

Nonselective beta-adrenergic blocking agents block

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both beta-1 and beta-2 adrenergic receptors, reducing heart rate, myocardial contractility, and cardiac output through beta-1 blockade, while also blocking beta-2 receptors in the bronchial smooth muscle and peripheral vasculature.

### **Nonsense Variant**

A sequence variant that creates a premature stop codon, potentially producing a truncated protein or triggering nonsense-mediated mRNA decay. The effect depends on the gene, location, transcript, and residual protein production.

### **Nonspecific Interstitial Pneumonia**

A pattern with uniform, temporally homogeneous inflammation and/or fibrosis. Most common ILD associated with connective tissue disease. HRCT shows bilateral ground-glass opacities with subpleural sparing.

### **Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drug**

A medicine that inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes and reduces prostaglandin production, producing analgesic, anti-inflammatory, and fever-reducing effects. NSAIDs can cause gastrointestinal, kidney, cardiovascular, or other adverse effects.

### **Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs**

Analgesic and anti-inflammatory drugs that inhibit cyclooxygenase enzymes and prostaglandin synthesis. Perioperative use requires assessment of renal function, gastrointestinal bleeding risk, platelet effects, cardiovascular risk, and surgical bleeding considerations.

### **Nontuberculous Mycobacterial Lung Disease**

Chronic lung infection caused by environmental *Mycobacterium* species other than *M. tuberculosis*. It may produce cough, fatigue, weight loss, breathlessness, or coughing blood, especially in people with structural lung disease. Diagnosis requires compatible imaging and repeated microbiologic testing; treatment is prolonged and individualized.

### **Nonunion And Malunion**

Nonunion is failure of a fractured bone to heal after an adequate period (generally 6-9 months for long bones) without clinical or radiographic evidence of progression toward union for 3 months. Classification: hypertrophic (viable ends, inadequate stability), atrophic (devitalized ends, poor biology), oligotrophic (intermediate).

### **Noonan Syndrome**

An inherited disorder of the RAS–MAPK signaling pathway, characterized by distinctive facial features, short stature, congenital heart disease, and variable developmental or bleeding problems.

### **Normal Flora**

The resident microorganisms (commensals) colonizing body surfaces—skin, oropharynx, gastrointestinal tract, genitourinary tract—without causing disease under normal conditions. They provide protection (colonization resistance, immune priming), synthesis of vitamins, and nutrient metabolism.

### **Normal Pressure Hydrocephalus**

A disorder of cerebrospinal-fluid circulation causing enlarged ventricles and a clinical pattern that may include gait impairment, cognitive decline, and urinary urgency or incontinence.

### **Normalization**

Correction for detector efficiency variations. Performed daily with uniform source.

### **Normocalcemic Hyperparathyroidism**

Condition of elevated parathyroid hormone with persistently normal serum calcium and normal vitamin D levels. Exclusion of secondary causes of elevated PTH including vitamin D deficiency, renal insufficiency, and medications is required. Represents an early or mild form of primary hyperparathyroidism. May progress to overt hypercalcemia.

### **Norovirus**

A single-stranded RNA virus that is the leading cause of gastroenteritis outbreaks worldwide. The virus is highly contagious and can cause large out-

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breaks in closed settings including hospitals, cruise ships, and nursing homes. Norovirus causes acute onset of vomiting and diarrhea. Diagnosis is made by PCR or antigen detection in stool.

### **Norovirus Infection**

A highly contagious viral gastroenteritis causing sudden nausea, vomiting, watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and sometimes fever. Illness is usually short but can cause dangerous dehydration, especially in infants, older adults, or medically vulnerable people. Oral rehydration and careful hand hygiene are central to management and prevention.

### **Norrie Disease**

An X-linked retinal disorder, usually caused by pathogenic variants in NDP, characterized by congenital or early-onset blindness from abnormal retinal development. Hearing loss, developmental differences, and peripheral vascular or vitreoretinal complications may occur.

### **Nose**

The external nasal structure and nasal cavities, the primary organ of olfaction and the entry to the respiratory tract. External nose: bone (nasal bones, frontal process of maxilla) and cartilage (septal, upper/lower lateral cartilages).

### **Nosebleed**

A nosebleed, or epistaxis, is bleeding from nasal blood vessels caused by dryness, trauma, inflammation, medications, hypertension, vascular disease, or less commonly a tumor or bleeding disorder. anterior nasal septum and result from local trauma, dryness, inflammation, or vascular disease; persistent or severe bleeding may require medical intervention.

#### **Synonyms:**

epistaxis.

### **Nosocomial**

Hospital-acquired. Nosocomial infection: infection acquired in hospital.

### **Nosocomial Infection**

A hospital-acquired infection developing during or

after hospitalization that was not present or incubating at admission, classically defined by onset beyond 48 hours. Common sites are bloodstream, urinary tract, lungs, and surgical wounds; causative organisms are frequently multidrug-resistant, prevented by hand hygiene and stewardship.

### **Notifiable Disease**

Disease required by law to be reported to health authorities. Examples: tuberculosis, measles, HIV, COVID-19.

### **NSAIDs**

Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs are a class of drugs that inhibit cyclooxygenase enzymes, COX-1 and COX-2, reducing the synthesis of prostaglandins and thromboxanes from arachidonic acid. They produce analgesic, anti-inflammatory, antipyretic, and antiplatelet effects.

### **NSAIDs (Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs)**

A class of analgesic, antipyretic, and anti-inflammatory drugs that inhibit cyclooxygenase (COX-1 and/or COX-2), reducing prostaglandin and thromboxane synthesis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs

### **NSTEMI**

Non-ST-elevation myocardial infarction: acute myocardial necrosis (elevated cardiac troponin) without persistent ST-segment elevation on ECG, caused by subtotal occlusion or distal embolization of a coronary artery. Features: chest pain, ECG changes (ST depression, T-wave inversion), elevated troponin.

### **Nuchal Translucency Screening**

An ultrasound measurement of the fluid-filled space at the posterior fetal nuchal region, performed at 11-14 weeks (crown-rump length 45-84 mm). Increased NT (>95th percentile or >3.0-3.5 mm) is associated with trisomies 21, 18, 13, Turner syndrome, and cardiac defects.

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## **Nuclear Medicine**

A medical specialty that uses small amounts of radioactive substances (radiotracers) to diagnose, stage, and treat various diseases, including cancer and heart disease.

## **Nuclear Medicine Documentation**

Record keeping for radioactive materials, including inventory, disposal, administered activity, and patient release.

## **Nuclear Medicine Reporting**

Structured interpretation of nuclear medicine studies using standardized terminology and clinically relevant findings.

## **Nuclear Medicine Resolution**

Ability of a PET or SPECT system to distinguish small details, limited by factors such as positron range, non-collinearity, and detector geometry.

## **Nuclear Sclerosis**

A common age-related cataract in which the central lens becomes increasingly yellow and hard. It can gradually reduce vision, alter color perception, and sometimes temporarily improve near vision.

## **Nuclear Stress Test**

Myocardial perfusion imaging during stress. Detects coronary artery disease.

## **Nucleoside Analogs**

A class of antiviral drugs that structurally resemble natural nucleosides and inhibit viral replication by interfering with DNA or RNA synthesis.

## **Number Needed To Harm**

The number of people exposed to an intervention for one additional person to experience a specified adverse outcome compared with the control over a defined time. It is the reciprocal of absolute risk increase.

## **Number Needed To Treat**

The number of people who must receive an inter-

vention for one additional person to experience the specified beneficial outcome compared with the control over a defined time. It is the reciprocal of absolute risk reduction.

## **Numbness And Tingling**

Abnormal sensations, also called paresthesias, that may result from nerve compression, peripheral neuropathy, spinal disease, vitamin deficiency, vascular problems, or neurologic disorders. Sudden one-sided symptoms require urgent evaluation for stroke.

### **Synonyms:**

paresthesias, that may result from nerve compression,.

## **Nummular Eczema**

Nummular eczema is an inflammatory skin disorder producing intensely itchy coin-shaped patches, often worsened by dry skin, irritation, or barrier disruption. erythematous, vesicular, or crusted plaques, typically on the extremities. The lesions are intensely pruritic and may be triggered by dry skin, skin trauma, or allergic contact dermatitis. It is more common in adults with atopic predisposition.

## **Nursing Home**

A residential facility that provides ongoing nursing care, assistance with daily activities, and medical or rehabilitation services for people who cannot live independently.

## **Nutcracker Esophagus**

Esophageal motility disorder characterized by high-amplitude peristaltic contractions exceeding 180 mmHg in the distal esophagus on manometry, with preserved peristaltic coordination. Presents with intermittent chest pain and dysphagia to solids and liquids.

## **Nutcracker Syndrome**

Compression of left renal vein between aorta and SMA causing hematuria and flank pain. Managed conservatively. Stenting or surgery for severe cases.

## **Nutrient Density**

Amount of nutrients per calorie. Whole foods more



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nutrient-dense than processed foods. Importance for weight management, health.

### **Nutrition (Geriatric)**

Nutritional assessment and intervention in elderly. Risks: malnutrition (undernutrition, obesity), micronutrient deficiencies (vitamin D, B12, calcium), dehydration. Assessment: weight, BMI, dietary intake, lab values. Interventions: supplementation, meal delivery, appetite stimulants, feeding assistance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Nutrition (Oncology)**

Nutritional care for people with cancer, addressing intake, symptoms, treatment effects, weight, muscle mass, and personal goals.

#### **Synonyms:**

Oncology

### **Nutrition Education**

Teaching patients about healthy eating. Cultural sensitivity, health literacy appropriate. Motivational interviewing effective.

### **Nutrition In Pregnancy**

A balanced diet providing adequate calories, protein, vitamins, and minerals to support maternal and fetal health. Additional caloric needs: 300 kcal/day in the second and third trimesters. Key nutrients: folic acid (400 mcg/day), iron (27 mg/day), calcium (1000 mg/day), vitamin D (600 IU/day), iodine (220 mcg/day), DHA (200-300 mg/day).

### **Nutrition Risk Screening 2002**

A validated screening tool for hospitalized adults that considers nutritional status and disease severity to identify patients likely to benefit from nutrition support. Screening is not itself a complete malnutrition diagnosis.

### **Nutrition-Focused Physical Examination**

A structured examination for physical findings associated with malnutrition, including loss of subcuta-

neous fat, muscle wasting, edema, ascites, reduced functional status, and micronutrient-related signs. It complements dietary history, anthropometry, laboratory data, and disease assessment.

### **Nutritional Assessment**

Comprehensive evaluation: dietary intake, anthropometrics, biochemical tests, clinical examination. Dietitian involvement essential.

### **Nutritional Dermatoses**

Nutritional deficiencies cause distinctive skin findings. Vitamin C deficiency (scurvy): perifollicular hemorrhage, corkscrew hairs, gingival bleeding. Niacin deficiency (pellagra): photosensitive dermatitis in sun-exposed areas, diarrhea, dementia.

### **Nutritional Screening**

Rapid assessment for malnutrition risk. Tools: MST, MNA, MUST. Screening all elderly patients recommended. Identifies need for comprehensive assessment.

### **NYHA Functional Classification**

A four-class system grading heart failure severity based on symptoms and exercise tolerance. Class I: no limitation of physical activity. Class II: slight limitation; comfortable at rest but ordinary activity causes symptoms. Class III: marked limitation; comfortable at rest but less than ordinary activity causes symptoms.

### **Nystagmus**

Nystagmus is involuntary rhythmic eye movement that can arise from vestibular disease, neurologic disorders, impaired vision, medication, or normal infant development. rotational, or mixed in pattern, and it is classified based on the underlying cause as infantile (developing in the first six months of life), acquired (developing later in life), or periodic alternating.

### **Nociceptors**

Sensory nerve endings that detect potentially tissue-damaging stimuli and transmit pain signals.



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### **Nonketotic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome**

A severe complication of diabetes marked by very high blood glucose, dehydration, and increased blood osmolality, usually without substantial ketoacidosis.

### **Normal-Pressure Hydrocephalus**

A disorder in which cerebrospinal fluid accumulates and causes gait difficulty, cognitive decline, and urinary problems despite near-normal measured pressure.

### **Nucleus Accumbens**

A brain region involved in reward, motivation, and reinforcement.

### **Nocardia Infection**

An infection caused by *Nocardia* bacteria, often affecting the lungs, skin, or brain.

### **Noma**

Noma is a rapidly progressive gangrenous infection of the mouth and face, usually in severely malnourished or immunocompromised children; it destroys oral and facial tissue and requires urgent antibiotics, nutrition, and surgery.

### **Non-Infectious Cystitis**

Inflammation of the bladder that is not caused by an infectious organism.

### **Nickel Allergy**

An allergic skin reaction caused by contact with nickel-containing materials.

### **Nightmare Disorder**

Repeated disturbing dreams that cause significant distress or interfere with sleep and daytime function.

### **Nonallergic Rhinitis**

Nasal congestion, sneezing, or runny nose caused by irritants or other triggers rather than an allergy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Rhinitis, Nonallergic Rhinitis, Vasomotor

### **Neuroglia**

Supporting cells of the nervous system that nourish, protect, and maintain neurons.

### **Neutrophils**

The most abundant type of white blood cell. Neutrophils rapidly migrate to sites of infection or injury and ingest microorganisms and cellular debris.

### **Non-Rapid Eye Movement Sleep**

Sleep consisting of stages N1, N2, and N3, with progressively deeper sleep and reduced responsiveness to the environment.

### **Nucleus Pulposus**

The soft, gel-like central portion of an intervertebral disk, surrounded by the annulus fibrosus.

### **Nutritional Anemia**

Anemia caused by inadequate intake, absorption, or use of nutrients needed for red-cell production, especially iron, vitamin B12, or folate.

### **Nondisjunction**

Failure of homologous chromosomes or sister chromatids to separate properly during cell division, producing cells with abnormal chromosome numbers.

### **Nontuberculous Mycobacterial Infection**

Infection caused by *Mycobacterium* species other than *M. tuberculosis*, often affecting the lungs but sometimes the lymph nodes, skin, or other organs. Disease is more likely in people with structural lung disease or impaired immunity.

### **Nuchal Rigidity**

Abnormal stiffness and resistance to passive flexion of the neck, classically associated with irritation or inflammation of the meninges, including meningitis or subarachnoid hemorrhage.

### **Nasal Septum Perforation**

A hole through the cartilage or bone separating the nasal passages, which may cause crusting, nose-

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bleeds, whistling, or obstruction and can result from trauma, surgery, intranasal drugs, or inflammatory disease.

### **Neurogenic Orthostatic Hypotension**

A fall in blood pressure on standing caused by failure of the autonomic nervous system to produce an adequate vasoconstrictor response. It may cause dizziness, fainting, or falls.

### **Nephroptosis (Floating Kidney)**

Abnormal downward movement of a kidney when a person stands, sometimes causing flank discomfort, urinary symptoms, or intermittent obstruction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Floating Kidney

### **Nephrotoxic**

Describing a substance or condition capable of damaging the kidneys or impairing their function.

### **Nerve Deafness (Sensorineural Deafness)**

Hearing loss caused by damage to the cochlea, auditory nerve, or central auditory pathways rather than blockage of sound transmission through the outer or middle ear.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sensorineural Deafness

### **Neuroanatomy**

The study of the structure and organization of the nervous system.

### **Neuroendocrinology**

The study of interactions between the nervous system and the endocrine system, including how the brain regulates hormone release.

### **Niacin (Nicotinic Acid, Vitamin B3)**

A water-soluble vitamin required for cellular energy metabolism; severe deficiency causes pellagra, with dermatitis, diarrhoea, and cognitive changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nicotinic Acid, Vitamin B3

### **Nipple**

The projection at the centre of the breast through which milk is released from the mammary ducts; it contains smooth muscle and sensory nerve endings.

### **Nipple Discharge**

Fluid released from a nipple outside normal breast-feeding; it may be physiological or associated with infection, duct disease, hormonal disturbance, or breast cancer.

### **Nipple Inversion Or Retraction**

Inward turning or pulling-in of the nipple. It may be longstanding and benign, but new unilateral inversion or retraction requires assessment for duct disease or breast cancer.

### **Nocturnal Enuresis (Bed-Wetting)**

Repeated involuntary urination during sleep in a child old enough to have achieved bladder control.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bed-Wetting

### **Nocturnal Emission**

Involuntary ejaculation during sleep, sometimes called a wet dream. It is a common and normal event during male puberty and adolescence.

### **Nocturnal Lagophthalmos**

Incomplete closure of the eyelids during sleep, which may cause dryness, irritation, and exposure injury to the cornea.

### **Night Terrors**

Episodes of abrupt partial awakening from deep non-REM sleep with intense fear, screaming, autonomic arousal, and limited recall afterward, occurring most often in children.

### **Nonconvulsive Status Epilepticus**

Ongoing seizure activity without prominent rhythmic limb jerking, often presenting as prolonged confusion, impaired awareness, or subtle twitching and requiring electroencephalographic confirmation and urgent treatment.

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### Nonunion Fracture

Failure of a broken bone to heal within the expected time and without progressive healing, often causing persistent pain, instability, or deformity.

### Nasal Vestibulitis

Inflammation or infection of the nasal vestibule, commonly caused by *Staphylococcus* bacteria and producing tenderness, crusting, redness, or small pustules near the nostrils.

### Necrotizing Pneumonia

Severe pneumonia in which infection causes necrosis and cavitation of lung tissue, often accompanied by sepsis, respiratory failure, or abscess formation.

### Nonspecific Interstitial Pneumonitis

An interstitial lung disease characterized by relatively uniform inflammation and fibrosis of the lung interstitium, often associated with connective-tissue disease, medications, or an unknown cause.

### Nuchal Cord

Wrapping of the umbilical cord around the fetal neck, occurring once or more times. It is common and often harmless, but monitoring during labor is needed if fetal heart-rate abnormalities occur.

### Nausea And Vomiting

Nausea is the urge to vomit; vomiting is forceful emptying of stomach contents. Causes include infection, medicines, pregnancy, migraine, obstruction, and other illnesses.

### Neck Pain: Symptom

Pain or stiffness in the neck caused by muscle strain, injury, arthritis, disc disease, nerve compression, or other conditions.

### Night Leg Cramps

Sudden, painful involuntary contractions of leg muscles occurring during sleep or rest, often affecting the calf or foot.

### Nosebleeds

Bleeding from blood vessels in the nose, commonly caused by dryness, irritation, injury, infection, allergies, medicines, or high blood pressure.

### NAFLD

Alternate index label; see *Fatty liver disease (MASLD)*.

### NEC

Alternate index label; see *Neuroendocrine tumors*.

### Nerve Compression

Alternate index label; see *Pinched nerve*.

### NET

Alternate index label; see *Neuroendocrine tumors*.

### Neuralgia, Postherpetic

Alternate index label; see *Postherpetic neuralgia*.

### Neuralgia, Trigeminal

Alternate index label; see *Trigeminal neuralgia*.

### Neurilemmoma

Alternate index label; see *Schwannoma*.

### Neurinomatosis

Alternate index label; see *Schwannomatosis*.

### Neurocardiogenic Syncope

Alternate index label; see *Vasovagal syncope*.

### Neuroendocrine Carcinoma Of The Skin

Alternate index label; see *Merkel cell carcinoma*.

### Neurofibromatosis Type I

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

### Neurofibromatosis Type II

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

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### Neurofibrosarcoma

Alternate index label; see *Malignant peripheral nerve sheath tumors (MPNST)*.

### Neuroma, Acoustic

Alternate index label; see *Acoustic neuroma (vestibular schwannoma)*.

### Neuroma, Plantar

Alternate index label; see *Morton neuroma*.

### Neuromyelitis Optica Spectrum Disorder

Neuromyelitis optica spectrum disorder is an autoimmune central nervous system disease causing attacks of optic neuritis, longitudinally extensive myelitis, or related brainstem and diencephalic syndromes.

### Neuropathy, Autonomic

Alternate index label; see *Autonomic neuropathy*.

### Neuropathy, Diabetic

Alternate index label; see *Diabetic neuropathy*.

### Neuropathy, Hereditary Motor And Sensory

Alternate index label; see *Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease*.

### Neuropathy, Peripheral

Alternate index label; see *Peripheral neuropathy*.

### Newborn Jaundice

Newborn jaundice is yellow discoloration from elevated bilirubin; physiologic patterns are common, but early, severe, rapidly rising, or conjugated jaundice requires evaluation for serious disease.

### NF1

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

### NF2

Alternate index label; see *NF2-related schwannomatosis (neurofibromatosis type 2)*.

### Nicotine Addiction

Alternate index label; see *Nicotine dependence*.

### NMO

Alternate index label; see *Neuromyelitis optica*.

### NMOSD

Alternate index label; see *Neuromyelitis optica*.

### Nocturnal Enuresis

Alternate index label; see *Bed-wetting*.

### Noise-Related Hearing Loss

Alternate index label; see *Hearing loss*.

### Nonischemic Priapism

Alternate index label; see *Priapism*.

### Nontropical Sprue

Alternate index label; see *Celiac disease*.

### Nonulcer Dyspepsia

Alternate index label; see *Functional dyspepsia*.

### Nonulcer Stomach Pain

Alternate index label; see *Functional dyspepsia*.

### Nose Fracture

Nose fracture examines nose fracture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Nail Abnormalities

Nail abnormalities include changes in color, shape, thickness, attachment, or growth caused by trauma, infection, skin disease, systemic illness, or medicines.

### Nail Care For Newborns

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to nail care for newborns; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

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## **Nail Injuries**

Nail injuries can damage the nail plate, bed, surrounding tissue, or bone and may cause blood under the nail, deformity, pain, or loss of the nail.

## **Nail Polish Poisoning**

Nail polish poisoning involves toxic exposure to nail polish poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Naphthalene Poisoning**

Naphthalene poisoning involves toxic exposure to naphthalene poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Naproxen Sodium Overdose**

Naproxen sodium overdose involves toxic exposure to naproxen sodium overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Nasal Corticosteroid Sprays**

Nasal corticosteroid sprays reduce mucosal inflammation and congestion in allergic rhinitis, nasal polyps, and some chronic sinus disorders; correct direction away from the septum limits irritation and nosebleeds.

## **Nasal Fracture - Aftercare**

Nasal fracture - aftercare examines nasal fracture - aftercare; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Nasal Mucosal Biopsy**

Nasal mucosal biopsy examines nasal mucosal biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Nasogastric Feeding Tube**

A medical device or care approach involving nasogastric feeding tube. Its purpose, indications, risks,

and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical setting.

## **Nasopharyngeal Culture**

Nasopharyngeal culture examines nasopharyngeal culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Natural Short Sleeper**

Natural short sleeper addresses care related to natural short sleeper, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Nausea And Acupressure**

Acupressure may help some people with nausea by applying pressure to selected points, but evidence varies and serious or persistent nausea requires evaluation.

## **Nausea And Vomiting – Adults**

Nausea and vomiting in adults can result from gastrointestinal disease, infection, medication, pregnancy, metabolic illness, neurologic disease, or obstruction; dehydration and alarm features guide urgency.

## **Neck Dissection**

Neck dissection examines neck dissection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Neck Dissection - Discharge**

Neck dissection - discharge examines neck dissection - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Neck Lump**

A neck lump may be an enlarged lymph node, cyst, thyroid lesion, infection, salivary lesion, or tumor; persistence, growth, hardness, or swallowing problems need assessment.

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### Neck Pain Or Spasms - Self Care

A clinical condition involving neck Pain Or Spasms - Self Care; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### Neck X-Ray

Neck x-ray examines neck x-ray; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Necrotizing Granuloma

A necrotizing granuloma is a granulomatous inflammatory lesion containing dead tissue, often associated with tuberculosis, fungal infection, or other destructive disease.

### Necrotizing Vasculitis

Necrotizing vasculitis is inflammation that damages and destroys blood-vessel walls, potentially causing ischemia, bleeding, skin lesions, kidney disease, or organ failure.

### Neonatal Cystic Fibrosis Screening Test

Neonatal cystic fibrosis screening test examines neonatal cystic fibrosis screening test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Neonatal Hypothyroidism

Neonatal hypothyroidism is inadequate thyroid hormone in a newborn and can impair brain development without early screening and treatment.

### Neonatal Respiratory Distress Syndrome

A clinical condition involving neonatal Respiratory Distress Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### Neonatal Weight Gain And Nutrition

A clinical or physiological concept involving neonatal weight gain and nutrition. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### Neonate

A neonate is a newborn infant during the first 28 completed days after birth, a period requiring attention to feeding, temperature, jaundice, infection, breathing, and transition to extrauterine life.

### Nerve Biopsy

Nerve biopsy examines nerve biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Nerve Conduction Velocity

Nerve conduction velocity examines nerve conduction velocity; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Nerve Damage From Diabetes - Self-Care

A biomedical term referring to nerve damage from diabetes - self-care; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Neurodegeneration With Brain Iron Accumulation (NBIA)

A biological substance or process involving neurodegeneration With Brain Iron Accumulation (NBIA); its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### Neurofibromatosis 2

Neurofibromatosis type 2 is an inherited tumor-predisposition disorder characterized especially by bilateral vestibular schwannomas and possible meningiomas, ependymomas, cataracts, or neuropathy.

### Neurofibromatosis-1

Neurofibromatosis type 1 is an inherited condition featuring café-au-lait macules, neurofibromas, axillary freckling, optic pathway gliomas, bone lesions, and variable learning or vascular complications.

### Neurologic Deficit

A neurologic deficit is loss or impairment of move-



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ment, sensation, coordination, speech, vision, cognition, or autonomic function from nervous-system disease or injury.

### **Neuronal Ceroid Lipofuscinoses (NCL)**

Neuronal ceroid lipofuscinoses are inherited neurodegenerative lysosomal storage diseases causing progressive seizures, vision loss, movement problems, and cognitive decline.

### **Neuropathy Secondary To Drugs**

Drug-induced neuropathy is peripheral nerve damage caused by a medicine or toxin, often producing numbness, burning pain, weakness, or altered reflexes; management may require dose reduction, withdrawal, and treatment of symptoms.

### **Neuroretinitis**

Neuroretinitis is inflammation of the optic nerve and retina, often causing vision loss and a characteristic macular star, with infectious or inflammatory causes.

### **Neurosciences**

Neurosciences are the scientific disciplines studying the nervous system, including its structure, function, development, disease, and treatment.

### **Neutropenia - Infants**

Infant neutropenia is an abnormally low absolute neutrophil count for age, increasing susceptibility to bacterial or fungal infection; causes include infection, immune destruction, marrow disease, and medicines.

### **Nevoid Basal Cell Carcinoma Syndrome**

Nevoid basal cell carcinoma syndrome refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Newborn Head Molding**

Newborn head molding is temporary shaping of the skull during labor, commonly resolving over days but distinguished from bleeding, fracture, or craniosynostosis.

### **Newborn Jaundice - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to newborn jaundice - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Newborn Jaundice - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Newborn jaundice - what to ask your doctor examines newborn jaundice - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Newborn Screening Tests**

Newborn screening tests examines newborn screening tests; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Niacin For Cholesterol**

Niacin lowers triglycerides and can raise HDL cholesterol, but its routine cardiovascular benefit is limited when added to effective statin therapy; flushing, liver injury, hyperglycaemia, and hyperuricaemia limit high-dose use.

### **Nicotine And Tobacco**

Nicotine and tobacco involves toxic exposure to nicotine and tobacco; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Nicotine Poisoning**

Nicotine poisoning causes early nausea, vomiting, salivation, dizziness, tachycardia, and agitation followed by weakness, bradycardia, seizures, or respiratory failure in severe exposure.

### **Nicotine Replacement Therapy**

Nicotine replacement therapy involves toxic exposure to nicotine replacement therapy; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

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### **NICU Consultants And Support Staff**

NICU consultants and support staff addresses care related to nicu consultants and support staff, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **NICU Staff**

NICU staff addresses care related to nicu staff, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Night Terrors In Children**

Night terrors are episodes of sudden fear, screaming, autonomic arousal, and apparent confusion during non-REM sleep; children usually remain difficult to awaken and have little memory afterward.

### **Nitric Acid Poisoning**

Nitric acid poisoning involves toxic exposure to nitric acid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Nitroblue Tetrazolium Blood Test**

Nitroblue tetrazolium blood test examines nitroblue tetrazolium blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Nitroglycerin Overdose**

Nitroglycerin overdose involves toxic exposure to nitroglycerin overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Non-Fatal Drowning**

A clinical or physiological concept involving non-fatal drowning. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma In Children**

Childhood non-Hodgkin lymphoma is a group of lymphoid cancers that may grow rapidly and requires biopsy, staging, and age-appropriate combination therapy.

### **Nonallergic Rhinopathy**

Nonallergic rhinopathy addresses care related to nonallergic rhinopathy, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Noninvasive**

A medical device or care approach involving noninvasive. Its purpose, indications, risks, and follow-up depend on the patient and clinical setting.

### **Noonan Syndrome With Multiple Lentigines**

A clinical condition involving noonan Syndrome With Multiple Lentigines; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Normal Growth And Development**

Normal growth and development addresses care related to normal growth and development, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Norovirus - Hospital**

Hospital-associated norovirus is an acute, highly contagious gastroenteritis causing vomiting and watery diarrhoea; control depends on isolation, handwashing with soap and water, environmental disinfection, and rehydration.

### **Nuchal Translucency Test**

Nuchal translucency test examines nuchal translucency test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Nuclear Ventriculography**

Nuclear ventriculography examines nuclear ventriculography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Nurse Practitioner (NP)**

Nurse practitioner (NP) examines nurse practitioner

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(np); interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Nursemaid's Elbow**

Nursemaid's elbow is subluxation of the radial head after sudden traction on a young child's extended or pronated arm; the child avoids using the arm, and gentle clinician reduction usually restores movement.

### **Nut Allergies**

Nut allergy is an immune-mediated reaction to tree nuts or peanuts that can cause hives, gastrointestinal or respiratory symptoms, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

### **Nutrition And Athletic Performance**

A clinical or physiological concept involving nutrition and athletic performance. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **NAFLD (Fatty Liver)**

Alternate index label for Fatty Liver.

### **Neck Pain And Dizziness**

Neck pain with dizziness may reflect muscle strain, migraine, inner-ear disease, medication, blood-pressure change, or less commonly vascular or neurologic disease. Sudden severe symptoms, weakness, speech or vision change, fainting, or inability to walk require emergency care.

### **Neoplasm Thymomic (Thymoma)**

Alternate index label for Thymoma.

### **Nephrolithiasis (Kidney Stones)**

Alternate index label for Kidney Stones.

### **Nerve Pinched (Pinched Nerve Overview)**

Alternate index label for Pinched Nerve Overview.

### **Neuropathic Pain (Nerve Pain)**

Alternate index label for Nerve Pain.

### **Neuropathic Pain (Pain Management: Neuropathic Pain)**

Alternate index label for Pain Management: Neuropathic Pain.

### **Neuropathy Autonomic Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Neuropathy Diabetic Peripheral (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Neuropathy Focal Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Neuropathy Proximal Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Newborn Jaundice (Neonatal Jaundice)**

Alternate index label for Neonatal Jaundice.

### **NHL (Non-Hodgkins Lymphomas)**

Alternate index label for Non-Hodgkins Lymphomas.

### **Nodule Thyroid (Thyroid Nodules)**

Alternate index label for Thyroid Nodules.

### **Noise Induced Hearing Loss And Its Prevention**

Noise-induced hearing loss is permanent injury to inner-ear hair cells from repeated or intense sound exposure, often with tinnitus or difficulty understanding speech. Limiting exposure, increasing distance, taking quiet breaks, and using well-fitted hearing protection reduce risk.

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### **Non-Hodgkins Lymphomas**

Non-Hodgkin lymphomas are a diverse group of cancers of B, T, or other lymphocytes, ranging from slow-growing to aggressive. Painless lymph-node enlargement, fever, night sweats, weight loss, or extranodal symptoms may occur; biopsy and staging determine treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

NHL (Non-Hodgkins Lymphomas)

### **Nonceliac Gluten Intolerance (Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance))**

Alternate index label for Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance).

### **Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance)**

Alternate index label for Intolerance.

### **Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs And Ulcers**

Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs can reduce stomach-protective prostaglandins and cause gastritis, ulcers, and gastrointestinal bleeding. Risk rises with age, prior ulcer, anticoagulants, steroids, kidney disease, and high doses; safer alternatives or acid protection may be needed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nonsteroidal Antiinflammatory Drugs (Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs And Ulcers)

### **Nonsteroidal Antiinflammatory Drugs (Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs And Ulcers)**

Alternate index label for Nonsteroidal Anti-inflammatory Drugs and Ulcers.

### **Norovirus Contagious (Is Norovirus Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Norovirus Contagious.

### **NPD (Narcissistic Personality Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Narcissistic Personality Disorder.

### **Nurture Theory Vs. Nature (Nature Vs Nurture Theory Genes Or Environment)**

Alternate index label for Nature vs Nurture Theory Genes or Environment.

### **Na (Sodium)**

A clinical or physiological concept involving na (sodium). Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Nail Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to nail care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Nail Furrows**

Nail furrows are grooves or depressions running across or along a nail; transverse Beau lines can follow systemic illness or trauma, while longitudinal ridges are often age-related but may reflect local or systemic disease.

### **Nasal Passage**

The nasal passages are air channels inside the nose that warm, humidify, filter, and conduct air toward the throat and lungs.

### **Naso-**

The term Naso- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **National Formulary**

A clinical or physiological concept involving national formulary. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **National Institutes Of Health (NIH)**

The National Institutes of Health is a U.S. federal agency that conducts and funds biomedical and public-health research.

### **Natural Immunity**

A clinical or physiological concept involving natural

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immunity. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Naturopathy**

Naturopathy is a system of complementary care emphasizing lifestyle and natural products; evidence and safety vary, and proven medical treatment should not be delayed.

### **Navel**

The navel, or umbilicus, is the scar left after the umbilical cord separates and marks the former connection between fetus and placenta.

### **NCS**

NCS commonly means nerve-conduction study, which measures electrical signals in peripheral nerves to evaluate neuropathy, nerve compression, or other disorders.

### **ND**

ND is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean naturopathic doctor, neurodevelopmental, or another term; the full meaning should be specified.

### **Neck**

The neck connects the head to the trunk and contains the cervical spine, airway, esophagus, thyroid, vessels, nerves, muscles, and lymph nodes.

### **Neck, Chronic Stiff**

Chronic neck stiffness may result from muscle strain, arthritis, disc disease, inflammatory illness, or neurologic problems; weakness, fever, trauma, or severe headache needs assessment.

### **Needlestick Injury**

A clinical condition involving needlestick Injury; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Negative Calorie Diet**

A negative-calorie diet is a misleading concept claiming some foods require more energy to digest than they provide; weight change depends on total energy

balance and nutrition.

### **Negative-Strand RNA Virus**

A negative-strand RNA virus carries genetic material that must first be copied into messenger RNA before its proteins can be made in host cells.

### **Neo- (Prefix)**

Neo- is a prefix meaning new or recently formed.

### **NEP**

NEP is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean neuroendocrine pancreatic tumor, nasoendotracheal procedure, or another clinical term.

### **Nephro-**

The term Nephro- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Nerve, Trigeminal**

Nerve, trigeminal refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Nervine**

A clinical or physiological concept involving nervine. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Nervous Colon Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving nervous Colon Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Nervous System, Peripheral (PNS)**

The peripheral nervous system includes nerves and ganglia outside the brain and spinal cord and carries sensory, motor, and autonomic signals.

### **Neurobiological Disorder**

A clinical condition involving neurobiological Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

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## Neurogenic

A clinical or physiological concept involving neurogenic. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## Neurological

A clinical or physiological concept involving neurological. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## Neuron-Specific Enolase (NSE)

Neuron-specific enolase is an enzyme marker that can rise in neuroendocrine tumors or neuronal injury but is not diagnostic by itself.

## Nexus

A clinical or physiological concept involving nexus. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## NF

NF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including neurofibromatosis, a group of genetic disorders causing nerve-sheath tumors and other features.

## NG

NG commonly means nasogastric, referring to a tube passed through the nose into the stomach, but the abbreviation has other uses.

## Nidus

A nidus is a focus or central site from which a process develops, such as a stone-forming core, infection focus, or vascular malformation.

## Nil Disease

A clinical condition involving nil Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Nit

A clinical or physiological concept involving nit. Its meaning and clinical importance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## Nitrogenous Base

A genetic or molecular biology term involving nitrogenous base. Its role depends on the relevant nucleic acid, gene, cell, or laboratory context.

## Nitrosoureas

A genetic or molecular biology term involving nitrosoureas. Its role depends on the relevant nucleic acid, gene, cell, or laboratory context.

## NMR

NMR, or nuclear magnetic resonance, measures how atomic nuclei respond to a magnetic field and is used in chemical analysis and imaging.

## Nomenclature

Nomenclature is the organized system used to name and classify diseases, organisms, chemicals, anatomy, medicines, or other entities.

## Nonagenarian

A nonagenarian is a person aged 90 through 99 years.

## Noncompliance

Noncompliance is an older term for not following an agreed treatment or care plan; clinicians increasingly use adherence or nonadherence and assess barriers without assuming intentional refusal.

## Nonpathogenic

Nonpathogenic means not ordinarily capable of causing disease in a given host or setting; an organism can still cause opportunistic infection when immunity or barriers are impaired.

## Nonsyndromic

Nonsyndromic means occurring without the additional characteristic features of a recognized syndrome; it may still be genetic, congenital, or clinically significant.

## Noonan Syndrome (NS)

Noonan syndrome is a RASopathy causing characteristic facial features, short stature, congenital



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heart disease, developmental variation, and sometimes bleeding or lymphatic abnormalities; it is usually autosomal dominant and genetically heterogeneous.

### **Norketamine**

Norketamine is an active metabolite of ketamine with NMDA-receptor antagonist activity; it contributes to ketamine's analgesic and psychoactive effects and may persist after the parent drug is cleared.

### **Normal Range**

Normal range is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### **NREM Sleep**

NREM sleep is non-rapid-eye-movement sleep, comprising stages from light sleep to deep slow-wave sleep and alternating with REM sleep.

### **NS**

NS is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly normal saline, a sterile sodium-chloride solution, or not significant; the full term should be stated.

### **NTD**

NTD commonly means neural-tube defect, a congenital brain or spinal-cord malformation associated with inadequate folate and other factors.

### **Nucleic Acid Hybridization**

A genetic or molecular biology term involving nucleic acid hybridization. Its role depends on the relevant nucleic acid, gene, cell, or laboratory context.

### **Nucleoside Bypass Therapy**

Nucleoside bypass therapy is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Null Mutation**

A genetic or molecular biology term involving null mutation. Its role depends on the relevant nucleic acid, gene, cell, or laboratory context.

### **Numb**

Numb means lacking normal sensation or emotional responsiveness; physical numbness can result from nerve, brain, circulation, metabolic, or medication-related problems.

### **Numbness (Numb)**

Numbness is reduced or absent sensation, often from nerve compression, neuropathy, stroke, spinal disease, circulation problems, or anesthetic effects.

### **Nurse Assistant**

A nurse assistant helps provide basic patient care such as bathing, mobility, feeding, measurements, and comfort under the direction of licensed staff.

### **Nicotine Dependence**

A pattern of compulsive nicotine use with cravings, loss of control, tolerance, and withdrawal symptoms when use is reduced or stopped.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dependence, Nicotine Nicotine Addiction

### **Neuroendocrine Tumors**

Tumors arising from cells that receive signals from the nervous system and produce hormones; they may be benign or malignant.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Neuroendocrine NEC NET

### **NF2-Related Schwannomatosis (Neurofibromatosis Type 2)**

A genetic disorder characterized by tumors involving nerves, especially bilateral vestibular schwannomas, with possible hearing loss, balance problems, and other nerve tumors.

#### **Synonyms:**

BANF Bilateral Acoustic Neurofibromatosis Central Neurofibromatosis MISME Multiple Inherited Schwannomas, Meningiomas, And Ependymomas

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Neurofibromatosis Type II NF2

### Neurodermatitis

A chronic itchy skin condition in which repeated scratching or rubbing causes thickened, irritated patches.

#### Synonyms:

Dermatitis, Scratch

### Nail Fungus

A fungal infection of a fingernail or toenail causing thickening, discoloration, brittleness, distortion, or separation from the nail bed.

#### Synonyms:

Toenail Fungus

### Numbness In Hands

Reduced or absent sensation in one or both hands, commonly caused by nerve compression, neuropathy, injury, circulation problems, or systemic disease.

### Neuromuscular Junction (Myoneural Junction)

The specialized synapse where a motor nerve ending communicates with a skeletal-muscle fibre to initiate contraction.

#### Synonyms:

Myoneural Junction

### Normal Labour

Spontaneous labour at term with regular uterine contractions, progressive cervical dilatation, and delivery through the birth canal without major complication.

### Natal Cleft

The groove between the buttocks, also called the intergluteal or sacral cleft.

### Neuropathic

Caused by disease or dysfunction of nerves; neuropathic skin symptoms may include burning, electric-shock pain, altered sensation, numbness, or itch.

### Neuroendocrine Integration

Coordination between the nervous and endocrine systems, in which neural signals regulate hormone secretion and hormones influence neural activity, behavior, metabolism, and physiological responses.

### Neutralizing Antibodies

Antibodies that bind a pathogen or its toxin and block its ability to enter cells, attach to tissues, or cause its usual biologic effects.

### Neurotoxicity

Injury or dysfunction of the nervous system caused by a medicine, drug, toxin, heavy metal, infection, or other harmful exposure.

### Nevus Sebaceus

A congenital or early-onset hamartoma of sebaceous and other adnexal structures, usually a yellow-orange hairless plaque on the scalp or face; secondary tumors may rarely arise within it.

### Nodular Melanoma

An invasive melanoma characterized by early vertical growth and a rapidly enlarging papule or nodule that may be pigmented or amelanotic.

### Nodular Fasciitis

A rapidly growing benign self-limited fibroblastic and myofibroblastic proliferation, usually presenting as a painful or tender superficial mass. It can mimic sarcoma clinically and microscopically.

### Neuromuscular Hamartoma

A rare benign developmental lesion in which mature skeletal muscle and nerve fascicles are intermixed, typically involving a major peripheral nerve and causing enlargement or neuropathic symptoms.

### Nerve Sheath Myxoma

A benign myxoid peripheral-nerve-sheath tumor, usually presenting as a slow-growing papule or nodule on the fingers, hands, or upper extremities.

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## Neurocytoma

A neuronal tumor composed of relatively uniform neurocytes, most often arising in the lateral ventricles as a central neurocytoma. It may obstruct cerebrospinal-fluid flow and is graded by proliferative activity and other features.

## Neuroendocrine Carcinoma

A malignant epithelial neoplasm showing neuroendocrine differentiation, characterized by tumor cells that express neuroendocrine markers and may secrete bioactive substances. It can arise in the lung, gastrointestinal tract, pancreas, genitourinary tract, or other organs and may be classified as well differentiated or poorly differentiated. Clinical findings vary by the primary site and stage; advanced disease may cause obstruction, bleeding, metastases, or hormone-mediated syndromes. Diagnosis integrates morphology, immunohistochemistry, grading, and staging, while treatment depends on differentiation, anatomic site, molecular features, and disease extent.



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### Obesity

Obesity is excess adipose tissue that impairs health, influenced by genetic, metabolic, environmental, behavioral, and social factors and associated with cardiometabolic, respiratory, musculoskeletal, and other disease.  $\geq 30 \text{ kg/m}^2$  (class I: 30-34.9, class II: 35-39.9, class III:  $\geq 40$ ). Major risk factor for type 2 diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular disease, sleep apnea, osteoarthritis, certain cancers, and reduced life expectancy.

### Object Of Addiction

A substance or rewarding behavior to which a person develops a harmful compulsive relationship.

### Occult

Hidden or not visible without microscopy or laboratory testing.

### Omega-3 Fatty Acids

Polyunsaturated fats found especially in fatty fish and some plant foods.

### Oat Cell Carcinoma

An older name for small-cell carcinoma of the lung, an aggressive neuroendocrine cancer strongly associated with tobacco exposure.

### Obesity Rating

A classification or score describing excess body weight, commonly based on body-mass index and sometimes waist circumference or health risk.

### Objective

Based on observable findings or measurements rather than personal feelings or impressions.

### Obligate

Required for a biological process or able to survive only under specified conditions, as in an obligate anaerobe.

### Obliteration

Complete closure, destruction, or disappearance of a space, channel, or lumen.

### Observation

Deliberate monitoring of a person, symptom, disease, or test result without immediate intervention.

### Obsession

A recurrent, intrusive, unwanted thought, image, or urge that causes distress and is difficult to control.

### Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD)

A disorder involving recurrent obsessions, compulsions, or both, which are time-consuming or cause significant distress or impairment.

### Obstipation

Severe constipation with inability to pass stool or gas, often suggesting intestinal obstruction.

### Occipital

Relating to the back of the head, the occipital bone, or the occipital lobe.

### Occiput

The posterior part of the skull or the back of the head.

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## **Occupation**

A person's usual work or activity; occupational history can identify exposures relevant to health.

## **Occupational Disease**

An illness caused or substantially contributed to by workplace exposures or conditions.

## **Occupational Health**

The field concerned with protecting and promoting workers' physical, mental, and social health.

## **Occupational Safety And Health**

Policies and practices that prevent work-related injury, illness, hazardous exposure, and unsafe conditions.

## **Ochre**

A yellow-brown earth pigment; ochre discoloration may describe skin or tissue pigmentation.

## **Ocular**

Relating to the eye or vision.

## **Oculist**

An older term for an eye specialist; modern usage distinguishes ophthalmologists and optometrists.

## **Oculomotor Nerve**

Cranial nerve III, controlling most eye movements, eyelid elevation, and pupil constriction.

## **Oculogyric Crisis**

A sustained, involuntary upward deviation of the eyes, often caused by medicines affecting dopamine pathways.

## **Oddi, Sphincter Of**

A circular muscle regulating the flow of bile and pancreatic juice into the duodenum.

## **Odontalgia**

Toothache or pain arising from a tooth or its supporting tissues.

## **Odontoblast**

A cell that produces dentin during tooth development and repair.

## **Odontoclast**

A cell that resorbs dental hard tissue, analogous to an osteoclast.

## **Odontogenesis**

Development and formation of teeth.

## **Odontology**

The study of teeth, their structure, development, diseases, and treatment.

## **Odontopathy**

Any disease or disorder of a tooth.

## **Odour**

A smell detected by the olfactory system; unusual body or breath odor can be a clinical clue.

## **Oedema**

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in interstitial tissues, causing swelling.

## **Oedipus Complex**

A historical psychoanalytic concept describing unconscious sexual attachment to one parent and rivalry with the other; it is not a modern medical diagnosis.

## **Oesophageal**

Relating to the oesophagus, the muscular tube carrying swallowed material from the pharynx to the stomach.

## **Oesophageal Atresia**

A congenital interruption or blind ending of the oesophagus, often associated with a tracheoesophageal fistula.

## **Oesophageal Varices**

Dilated submucosal veins of the oesophagus, usually



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caused by portal hypertension and capable of life-threatening bleeding.

### **Oesophagoscopy**

Endoscopic examination of the oesophagus.

### **Oesophagus**

The muscular tube that transports swallowed food and liquid from the pharynx to the stomach.

### **Oesophagus, Diseases Of**

Disorders affecting the oesophagus, including reflux, inflammation, strictures, motility disorders, cancer, and congenital abnormalities.

### **Oestradiol**

The principal naturally occurring estrogen during the reproductive years.

### **Oestriol**

An estrogen produced in substantial amounts by the placenta during pregnancy.

### **Oestrogens**

A group of steroid hormones involved in reproductive development, menstrual cycling, pregnancy, bone, and other physiological functions.

### **Oestrone**

An estrogen produced by the ovaries and peripheral conversion of androgens, especially after menopause.

### **Off-Label**

Use of an approved medicine for an indication, dose, route, or population not specified in its regulatory approval.

### **Ofloxacin**

A fluoroquinolone antibiotic used for selected susceptible bacterial infections.

### **Ohm**

The SI unit of electrical resistance, equal to one volt per ampere.

### **Oidiomycosis**

An older term for infection caused by yeast-like fungi, historically including candidiasis.

### **Oidium**

A fragment or spore-like fungal element formed by fragmentation of a hypha; the term is also used in older fungal classifications.

### **Oil**

A hydrophobic liquid used as a nutrient, solvent, emollient, or medicinal preparation; safety depends on the specific oil.

### **Old Age**

Later life; health assessment should consider function, comorbidity, cognition, and social circumstances rather than age alone.

### **Olecranon**

The prominent bony process at the proximal end of the ulna forming the point of the elbow.

### **Oleic Acid**

A monounsaturated fatty acid abundant in olive oil and many other dietary fats.

### **Oleum**

A concentrated preparation of sulfur trioxide in sulfuric acid, highly corrosive and hazardous.

### **Olfactory**

Relating to the sense of smell or the olfactory nerve and pathways.

### **Oligo-**

A combining form meaning few, scanty, or deficient.

### **Oligocythaemia**

An abnormally low number of cells in the blood, especially red blood cells; the term is uncommon.

### **Oligodendrocyte**

A central-nervous-system glial cell that forms myelin

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around axons.

### **Oligodontia**

Congenital absence of many teeth, usually more than six permanent teeth, excluding third molars.

### **Oligomenorrhoea**

Infrequent menstrual periods, usually with cycles longer than about 35 days.

### **Oligophrenia**

An obsolete term for intellectual disability or impaired mental development.

### **Oligospermia**

A low sperm concentration in semen, assessed using current laboratory reference standards.

### **Olivary**

Relating to the olive-shaped inferior olivary nucleus of the medulla or to an olive-like structure.

### **Olive Oil**

A plant oil rich in monounsaturated fatty acids, used as food and in some topical preparations.

### **Ollier's Disease**

A nonhereditary skeletal disorder with multiple enchondromas, causing deformity, limb-length discrepancy, and an increased risk of malignancy.

### **Omnivore**

An organism that eats both plant and animal matter; it is a dietary term rather than a disease.

### **Onco-**

A combining form relating to tumors or cancer.

### **Oncology**

The medical specialty concerned with cancer prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and survivorship.

### **Oncotoxic**

Toxic to tumor cells or relating to substances that

damage cancer cells.

### **Onychia**

Inflammation of the nail bed or nail matrix.

### **Onycho-**

A combining form relating to the nail.

### **Onychogryphosis**

Marked thickening and curvature of a nail, often resembling a claw.

### **Oogenesis**

Formation and maturation of egg cells in the ovary.

### **Operable**

Able to be treated or corrected by surgery, or suitable for surgical intervention.

### **Operation**

A planned surgical procedure or, more generally, an action or process.

### **Operative Dentistry**

The branch of dentistry concerned with restoring teeth affected by caries, fracture, or defects.

### **Operator**

A person who performs a procedure or operates equipment; in healthcare, training and authorization are essential.

### **Operculum**

A lid, covering, or flap-like structure; in anatomy it may cover an opening or cortical region.

### **Ophthalmia**

Inflammation of the eye, especially the conjunctiva or other superficial ocular tissues.

### **Ophthalmic**

Relating to the eye; an ophthalmic medicine is intended for ocular use.

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## **Ophthalmology**

The medical specialty concerned with eye disease, vision, and ocular surgery.

## **Opium**

The dried latex of *Papaver somniferum* containing opioid alkaloids; it can cause dependence and respiratory depression.

## **Opponens**

A muscle that produces opposition, especially the thumb's movement across the palm.

## **Opsonin**

A molecule, such as IgG or complement C3b, that coats a microbe and enhances its uptake by phagocytes.

## **Optic**

Relating to vision, the eye, or the optic nerve.

## **Optic Chiasm**

The X-shaped junction where nasal retinal fibers of the optic nerves cross.

## **Optics**

The study and application of light, lenses, and image formation, including visual optics.

## **Optometrist**

A trained eye-care professional who examines vision and many ocular conditions and prescribes optical correction within local scope of practice.

## **Oral**

Relating to the mouth or administered through the mouth.

## **Oral Rehydration Therapy**

Replacement of water and electrolytes by drinking a balanced glucose-electrolyte solution, especially during diarrheal illness.

## **Orange Peel Skin**

Peau d'orange, a dimpled skin appearance caused by edema or lymphatic obstruction, classically considered in breast disease.

## **Orbicularis**

A circular muscle surrounding an opening, such as orbicularis oculi around the eye or orbicularis oris around the mouth.

## **Orbit**

The bony cavity containing the eye, extraocular muscles, nerves, vessels, and supporting tissues.

## **Orbital**

Relating to the orbit or structures within it.

## **Orchialgia**

Pain in one or both testes.

## **Orchidectomy**

Surgical removal of one or both testes, also called orchiectomy.

## **Organelle**

A specialized structure within a cell that performs a particular function.

## **Organic**

Relating to living matter or carbon-containing chemistry; in psychiatry, an older term for symptoms caused by a physical brain disorder.

## **Organic Disease**

A disorder caused by demonstrable structural or physiological pathology, as opposed to symptoms without an identified organic basis.

## **Organic Psychosis**

An obsolete term for psychosis caused by a physical brain disease, substance, or medical condition.

## **Organism**

An individual living thing, including a human, ani-

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mal, plant, fungus, or microorganism.

### **Organotherapy**

An obsolete treatment approach using extracts or tissues from organs to treat disease.

### **Organ Transplant**

Surgical transfer of an organ from a donor to a recipient to replace failing organ function.

### **Orgasm**

The peak of sexual pleasure accompanied by characteristic physiologic responses.

### **Orgasmic Dysfunction**

Persistent difficulty, delay, absence, or marked reduction of orgasm causing distress or impairment.

### **Orientation**

Awareness of personal identity, place, time, and situation.

### **Orlistat**

A gastrointestinal lipase inhibitor used with dietary measures for weight management.

### **Ornithosis**

Psittacosis, an infection caused by *Chlamydia psittaci* and acquired mainly from infected birds.

### **Orthodontist**

A dentist specializing in diagnosis and treatment of malocclusion and tooth or jaw alignment.

### **Orthopaedics**

The British spelling of orthopedics, the medical and surgical specialty concerned with the musculoskeletal system.

### **Orthopaedic Surgery**

Surgical treatment of disorders and injuries of bones, joints, muscles, ligaments, and related tissues.

### **Orthoptic**

Relating to assessment and treatment of binocular vision, eye alignment, and disorders such as strabismus.

### **Ortolani's Test**

A hip examination maneuver in infants that detects a reducible dislocation by producing a palpable clunk as the femoral head enters the acetabulum.

### **Os**

A bone or bony structure; in Latin anatomical terminology it means bone, while in obstetrics it means an opening.

### **Oschophoria**

A rare or historical term whose precise clinical meaning varies across references; the source-specific definition should be verified.

### **Oscillation**

Repeated movement or variation around a central position or value.

### **Oscillator**

A device or system that produces repeated periodic movement or an electrical signal.

### **Oscillograph**

An instrument that records changing electrical or mechanical signals over time.

### **Oscillopsia**

The disturbing illusion that the visual environment is moving or bouncing, often caused by vestibular or eye-movement dysfunction.

### **Osiander's Sign**

An older sign described in pregnancy assessment; its use and definition vary by source and should be verified.

### **Osmidrosis**

Offensive-smelling perspiration, usually from bacterial breakdown of sweat and skin material.

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**Osmium**

A dense metallic element; some osmium compounds are highly toxic and can damage the eyes and respiratory tract.

**Osmolarity**

The concentration of osmotically active particles per liter of solution.

**Osmoreceptor**

A sensory cell or neural receptor that detects changes in osmotic concentration, especially in the hypothalamus.

**Ossicle**

A small bone, especially one of the three auditory bones in the middle ear.

**Ossification**

Formation of bone tissue.

**Osteitis**

Inflammation of bone, caused by infection, trauma, inflammatory disease, or other processes.

**Osteoarthritis**

A misspelling of osteoarthritis, a degenerative joint disorder involving cartilage and subchondral bone.

**Osteoarthrosis**

Another term for osteoarthritis or degenerative joint disease.

**Osteochondritis**

Inflammation or injury involving bone and its overlying cartilage.

**Osteogenesis**

Formation and development of bone.

**Osteoid**

The unmineralized organic matrix produced by bone-forming cells.

**Osteology**

The study of bones.

**Osteoma**

A benign tumor composed of mature bone.

**Osteophyte**

A bony projection arising at a joint margin, commonly associated with osteoarthritis.

**Ostium**

A natural opening or mouth of a vessel, duct, cavity, or organ.

**Otalgia**

Ear pain.

**Otic Barotrauma**

Injury to the ear caused by failure to equalize pressure during flying, diving, or other pressure changes.

**Otitis**

Inflammation of the ear.

**Otitis Externa**

Inflammation or infection of the external ear canal, commonly causing ear pain and tenderness.

**Synonyms:**

Swimmers Ear (Otitis Externa)

**Otitis Media**

Inflammation or infection of the middle ear, often following an upper-respiratory infection.

**Otolaryngology**

The medical specialty concerned with the ear, nose, throat, head, and neck.

**Otoliths**

Calcium-carbonate crystals in the vestibular organs that sense gravity and linear acceleration.

**Otology**

The study and medical care of the ear and hearing.

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## Oto-Rhino-Laryngology

Another name for otolaryngology, the specialty of the ear, nose, throat, head, and neck.

## Otorrhoea

Discharge of fluid or pus from the ear.

## Otosclerosis

Abnormal remodeling and fixation of middle-ear bone, commonly causing progressive conductive hearing loss.

## Otoscope

An instrument used to examine the ear canal and eardrum.

## Otoscopy

Examination of the ear canal and tympanic membrane with an otoscope.

## Ouabain

A cardiac glycoside that inhibits sodium-potassium ATPase; it is mainly of historical or research interest.

## Outcome

The result or endpoint of a disease, treatment, exposure, or healthcare intervention.

## Outpatient

A person receiving healthcare without being admitted overnight to a hospital.

## Output

The amount produced or excreted by a system, such as urine output or cardiac output.

## Ova

Plural of ovum; eggs or egg cells, and in parasitology, eggs of worms or other parasites.

## Ovarian

Relating to an ovary.

## Ovarian Cysts

Fluid-filled or partly solid sacs in or on an ovary; many are benign and resolve spontaneously, but some cause pain or complications.

### Synonyms:

Cyst, Ovarian Cysts Ovary (Ovarian Cysts)

## Ovariectomy

Surgical removal of one or both ovaries.

## Ovariectomy

An older term for surgical removal or incision of an ovary.

## Ovary

A female reproductive organ that releases ova and produces hormones including estrogen and progesterone.

## Over-Counter

An incomplete or nonstandard form usually intended to mean over-the-counter, describing medicines available without a prescription.

## Overdose

Exposure to a dose of a medicine or substance that exceeds the person's safe or intended amount and may cause toxicity.

## Over-Hydration

Excess accumulation of body water, which may cause edema, dilutional hyponatremia, or heart and lung complications.

## Over-Nutrition

Excessive intake or accumulation of energy or nutrients that can contribute to obesity, metabolic disease, or toxicity.

## Overriding Aorta

A congenital heart defect in which the aorta is positioned over a ventricular septal defect and receives blood from both ventricles, classically in tetralogy of Fallot.



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## Overweight

Body weight above the usual range for height, commonly defined in adults as BMI 25 to less than 30 kg/m<sup>2</sup>, with context-dependent limitations.

## Oviduct

A tube carrying an ovum from the ovary toward the uterus; in humans it is the uterine or fallopian tube.

## Ovulation

Release of a mature egg from an ovarian follicle, usually around the middle of the menstrual cycle.

## Ovule

An immature seed in plants or, historically, an ovum or small egg-like structure.

## Ovum

A mature female reproductive cell, or egg.

## Oxalate

A salt or ester of oxalic acid that can form kidney stones and binds calcium.

## Oxalic Acid

A dicarboxylic acid whose oxalate salts can contribute to calcium-oxalate kidney stones; concentrated exposure is toxic.

## Oxazepam

A benzodiazepine anxiolytic and sedative with risks of dependence, sedation, and respiratory depression.

## Oxide

A compound formed when oxygen combines with another element.

## Oximeter

A device that measures oxygen saturation or related optical signals, commonly by pulse oximetry.

## Oxybuprocaine

A topical ester local anesthetic used mainly for ocular surface anesthesia.

## Oxycephaly

A cone-shaped skull caused by premature fusion of cranial sutures, also called acrocephaly.

## Oxygen

A gas essential for aerobic metabolism and tissue energy production.

## Oxygen Content

The amount of oxygen carried in blood, mainly bound to hemoglobin with a small dissolved component.

## Oxygen Debt

An older term for the increased oxygen consumption after exercise needed to restore metabolic and physiologic conditions; excess post-exercise oxygen consumption is preferred.

## Oxygen Therapy

Administration of supplemental oxygen to correct or prevent inadequate tissue oxygenation.

## Oxyhaemoglobin

Hemoglobin reversibly bound to oxygen.

## Oxymetazoline

A topical alpha-adrenergic agonist used as a nasal decongestant or ocular vasoconstrictor; prolonged nasal use can cause rebound congestion.

## Oxytocic

Causing or promoting uterine contraction, especially a medicine such as oxytocin.

## Oxytocin

A hormone that stimulates uterine contractions and milk ejection; it is also used therapeutically in obstetrics.

## Oxyuriasis

Infection with pinworms, especially *Enterobius vermicularis*, causing perianal itching and disturbed sleep.

**Synonyms:**

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n-3 fatty acids

### **Omega-6 Fatty Acids**

Essential polyunsaturated fats found in many plant oils and foods.

**Synonyms:**

n-6 fatty acids

### **Ondine's Curse**

A rare disorder of automatic breathing in which ventilation may fail during sleep.

**Synonyms:**

Congenital central hypoventilation syndrome

### **Ophthalmologist**

A medical doctor specializing in diseases and surgery of the eyes.

### **Opioid**

A natural or synthetic substance that acts on opioid receptors to relieve pain and may cause sedation or dependence.

### **Optician**

A technician who fits and dispenses eyeglasses or contact lenses.

### **Orthopedist**

A physician specializing in disorders and injuries of bones, joints, muscles, and related tissues.

**Synonyms:**

Orthopedic surgeon

### **Osteoblasts**

Cells that form new bone.

### **Osteoclasts**

Cells that break down and resorb bone tissue.

### **Osteocytes**

Mature bone cells embedded within bone tissue that help maintain it.

### **Osteons**

Cylindrical structural units of compact bone arranged around central canals.

**Synonyms:**

Haversian systems

### **Osteopath**

A physician trained in medicine and surgery who earns a Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine degree.

**Synonyms:**

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### **Oxidant**

A reactive molecule that can damage cells and tissues by promoting oxidation.

**Synonyms:**

Oxidizing agent

### **Oxidation**

A chemical process that changes a substance through loss of electrons or reaction with oxygen.

### **Oxygenated Blood**

Blood that has acquired oxygen in the lungs and carries it to body tissues.

### **Obesity Hypoventilation Syndrome**

Chronic daytime hypercapnia in obese individuals without other causes. Reduced chest wall compliance and blunted respiratory drive. Often coexists with OSA. Treatment: weight loss and BiPAP.

### **Obex Region**

The caudal tip of the fourth ventricle where it narrows into the central canal of the spinal cord. It lies near the dorsal medulla and is an important anatomical landmark in the floor of the ventricular system.

### **Objective Response Rate**

The proportion of patients whose tumor shrinks by a predefined amount (complete or partial response) during treatment; a common efficacy endpoint in oncology trials.

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## Oblique Plane

A plane that passes through the body or an organ at an angle other than a right angle (diagonal plane).

## Obsessions

Recurrent, persistent, intrusive, and unwanted thoughts, urges, or images that are experienced as intrusive and cause marked anxiety or distress. Common obsessions include contamination fears, fears of harming oneself or others, need for symmetry, taboo thoughts (sexual, religious, or aggressive), and doubt.

## Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder

Characterized by the presence of obsessions, compulsions, or both. Obsessions are recurrent, persistent, intrusive, and unwanted thoughts, urges, or images that cause marked anxiety or distress. The individual attempts to ignore or suppress them or neutralize them with some other thought or action.

## Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder

A pattern of preoccupation with orderliness, perfectionism, and mental and interpersonal control, at the expense of flexibility and efficiency.

## Obstetric Anal Sphincter Injury

A third- or fourth-degree perineal tear involving the anal sphincter complex during childbirth. It requires accurate examination, repair, follow-up, and assessment for bowel or continence problems.

## Obstetric Ultrasound

Ultrasound imaging during pregnancy. First trimester: dating, viability. Second trimester: anatomy survey. Third trimester: growth, position.

## Obstetrician

A medical doctor who specializes in the care of women during pregnancy, labor, and the postpartum period (obstetrics). Obstetricians manage normal and high-risk pregnancies, perform cesarean deliveries and assisted vaginal deliveries, and treat pregnancy complications (pre-eclampsia, gestational diabetes, hemorrhage, preterm labor).

## Obstetrics

The branch of medicine and surgery concerned with the care of women during pregnancy, childbirth, and the postpartum period.

## Obstructed Infected Urinary System

Urinary tract obstruction accompanied by infection, pyonephrosis, or sepsis. It is a urologic emergency requiring immediate resuscitation, antimicrobial therapy, and urgent decompression by nephrostomy or ureteral stent.

## Obstruction

Blockage of urinary flow. Ureteral, urethral, bladder outlet. Causes: stones, stricture, tumor, BPH. Complications: hydronephrosis, infection, renal failure.

## Obstructive Jaundice

Jaundice caused by obstruction of bile flow from the liver to the duodenum, resulting in accumulation of conjugated bilirubin in the blood. See Jaundice for complete overview.

## Obstructive Nephropathy

Kidney damage caused by blockage of urine flow anywhere from the kidney to the urethra. Causes include stones, tumors, strictures, enlarged prostate, and congenital abnormalities; untreated obstruction can lead to hydronephrosis, infection, and kidney failure.

## Obstructive Parotitis

Inflammation of the parotid gland resulting from obstruction of the parotid duct, most commonly by sialolithiasis, presenting with painful glandular swelling that worsens with meals. The obstruction leads to stasis, secondary bacterial infection, and recurrent episodes of swelling and tenderness.

## Obstructive Shock

A form of shock caused by physical obstruction of blood flow outside the heart, reducing cardiac output despite normal cardiac function.

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## **Obstructive Sleep Apnea**

Recurrent partial or complete upper-airway collapse during sleep, causing disrupted breathing and often daytime symptoms. Evaluation may include sleep testing; treatment is individualized and can include positive-airway-pressure therapy, weight management, oral appliances, positional therapy, or surgery.

### **Synonyms:**

Sleep Apnea, Obstructive

## **Obstructive Uropathy**

Urinary tract obstruction at any level from the renal pelvis to the urethra, leading to impaired urine flow and potential renal damage. Causes include nephrolithiasis, benign prostatic hyperplasia, ureteral strictures, tumors of the bladder, prostate, or cervix, and external compression from lymphadenopathy or retroperitoneal fibrosis.

## **Obturator**

A structure that occludes an opening. In anatomy, the obturator foramen is a large opening in the pelvic bone, closed by the obturator membrane. The obturator nerve (L2–L4) innervates the adductor muscles of the thigh and provides sensory innervation to the medial thigh. The obturator artery supplies the adductor compartment.

## **Obturator Hernia**

Herniation of abdominal contents through the obturator canal, most commonly occurring in thin elderly women with a history of multiple pregnancies. It is a rare cause of small bowel obstruction and may present with the Howship-Romberg sign of medial thigh pain from obturator nerve compression.

## **Obtuse Marginal Artery**

A branch of the circumflex coronary artery that runs along the obtuse margin of the heart and supplies the lateral wall of the left ventricle. Its size and number vary with coronary anatomy.

## **Occipital Bone**

Forms the posterior-inferior cranium surrounding the foramen magnum (spinal cord passage). Has basilar, lateral, and squamous parts. Occipital

condyles articulate with C1 for nodding movement. The external occipital protuberance provides muscle attachment.

## **Occipital Lobe**

The most posterior of the four cerebral lobes, located behind the parieto-occipital sulcus and above the tentorium cerebelli. The occipital lobe is the primary visual processing center of the brain.

## **Occipital Neuralgia**

A paroxysmal, severe, stabbing or electric shock-like pain in the distribution of the greater, lesser, or third occipital nerves (posterior scalp, from the nuchal line to the vertex).

## **Occiput Posterior Position**

A fetal head position in which the occiput faces the maternal sacrum. It may cause back pain or slow labor, although the fetus may rotate during labor.

## **Occiput Transverse Position**

The fetal head presenting with the sagittal suture oriented transversely. Usually the normal descent position; most rotate to OA with contractions. When persistent, it can cause protracted descent and prolonged second stage.

## **Occlusal Guard**

Appliance protecting teeth from attrition. Night guard for bruxism. Sports mouthguard.

## **Occlusion**

Complete blockage of vessel. May be natural (thrombosis) or iatrogenic (embolization).

## **Occult Blood**

Blood that is not visible to the naked eye and is detected by chemical or immunochemical testing. Fecal occult-blood tests may be used in colorectal-cancer screening; the test type and collection instructions determine whether dietary or medicine restrictions apply.

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### **Occult Gastrointestinal Bleeding**

Chronic or intermittent gastrointestinal blood loss that is not visible to the patient and may not produce melaena or haematochezia. It commonly presents with iron-deficiency anaemia or a positive faecal blood test.

### **Occupational Asthma**

Asthma from workplace exposures to sensitizers (isocyanates, flour, latex) or irritants. Improves away from work and worsens at work. Serial peak flow monitoring supports diagnosis.

### **Occupational COPD**

Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease associated with workplace exposure to dust, chemicals, fumes, or other inhaled hazards. Symptoms and risk depend on the exposure and other factors, including smoking.

### **Occupational Dermatoses**

Work-related skin diseases. Occupational contact dermatitis accounts for 90 percent of occupational skin diseases. Irritant contact dermatitis is more common (hands, wet work) than allergic contact dermatitis. Occupations at risk include healthcare workers, hairdressers, construction workers, food handlers, and metalworkers.

### **Occupational Exposure**

Radiation exposure to nuclear medicine staff. Monitored with dosimeters. Limits: 50 mSv/year whole body, 150 mSv/year lens, 500 mSv/year extremities.

### **Occupational Exposure Limit**

A regulatory or advisory concentration or dose limit intended to reduce worker exposure to a hazardous substance over a defined averaging period. Limits vary by substance, jurisdiction, route, and whether the value is a ceiling, short-term limit, or time-weighted average.

### **Occupational Hearing Loss**

Permanent sensorineural hearing impairment caused by repeated or prolonged exposure to workplace noise or ototoxic hazards. Prevention depends on

reducing exposure and using effective hearing protection.

### **Occupational Medicine**

The medical specialty concerned with the effects of work on health, prevention of work-related illness and injury, and safe return to work.

### **Occupational Rehabilitation**

Services that help a person regain or adapt the skills needed for work after illness, injury, or disability.

### **Occupational Therapy**

OT helps patients perform daily activities (ADLs, IADLs) through therapeutic activities, adaptive equipment, environmental modification. Focus on upper extremity function, cognition, sensory integration.

### **Occupational Therapy Assessment**

Evaluation of a person's ability to perform daily activities, work, and other meaningful occupations, including factors affecting performance and the need for adaptive strategies or equipment.

### **OCD**

Obsessive-compulsive disorder, a condition involving recurrent unwanted thoughts or urges and/or repetitive behaviors or mental acts that cause distress or interfere with daily life.

#### **Synonyms:**

Obsessive Compulsive Disorder (OCD)

### **Ochronosis**

A blue-black or brownish pigmentation of connective tissues (cartilage, skin, sclerae, tendons) caused by accumulation of homogentisic acid and its oxidation products.

### **Octreoscan**

Nuclear medicine imaging using In-111 octreotide. Detects neuroendocrine tumors.

### **Ocular Histoplasmosis Syndrome**

Ocular disease following prior subclinical Histo-

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plasma capsulatum infection, characterized by punched-out peripheral chorioretinal scars, peripapillary atrophy, and choroidal neovascularization that causes central vision loss. Active choroidal neovascularization is treated with anti-VEGF therapy.

### **Ocular Hypertension**

Persistently elevated intraocular pressure without demonstrable glaucomatous optic-nerve damage or corresponding visual-field loss. It increases future glaucoma risk and requires individualized assessment of corneal thickness, optic-nerve appearance, pressure, and other risk factors.

### **Ocular Myiasis**

Infestation of the eye or ocular adnexa by fly larvae, which may involve the conjunctiva, cornea, or intraocular structures, presenting with pain, irritation, tearing, and visual disturbance. In severe cases, larvae can penetrate the globe causing endophthalmitis and blindness.

### **Ocular Pain**

Pain in or around the eye caused by surface irritation, infection, inflammation, trauma, glaucoma, or orbital disease. Severe pain with vision loss, light sensitivity, nausea, or injury requires urgent ophthalmic assessment.

### **Ocular Surface Disease**

A group of disorders affecting the cornea, conjunctiva, eyelids, and tear film, including dry eye, blepharitis, meibomian-gland dysfunction, and exposure-related disease. Symptoms and signs reflect tear-film instability, inflammation, epithelial injury, or abnormal lid function.

### **Oculocerebrorenal Syndrome**

An inherited peroxisomal disorder, also called Zellweger spectrum disorder, affecting the brain, eyes, kidneys, liver, and other organs. Severe forms present neonatally with hypotonia, seizures, feeding difficulty, distinctive facial features, and profound developmental impairment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Zellweger spectrum disorder, affecting.

### **Odds Ratio**

Ratio of odds of exposure in cases vs. controls. Used in case-control studies. OR approximates RR for rare diseases.

### **Odontogenic Cutaneous Fistula**

An abnormal tract connecting the skin surface to a periapical dental infection, typically presenting as a draining sinus tract on the chin, cheek, or submandibular region. It results from chronic dental infection eroding through the bone and soft tissue to the skin surface.

### **Odontogenic Keratocyst**

Aggressive cyst with high recurrence. Associated with nevoid basal cell carcinoma syndrome (Gorlin syndrome). Treatment: enucleation, resection, or decompression.

### **Odontoid Process**

A tooth-like projection superiorly from the body of the axis (C2 vertebra). The odontoid process projects into the atlas (C1) and is held in place by the transverse ligament of the atlas, allowing rotation of the head (the atlantoaxial joint accounts for 50% of cervical rotation).

### **Odontoma**

Hamartomatous dental tissue mass. Compound (multiple tooth-like structures) or complex (amorphous calcified mass). Treatment: surgical removal.

### **Odor Threshold**

Lowest concentration detectable by smell. Important for warning properties of toxins.

### **Odynophagia**

Painful swallowing, characterized by a burning, squeezing, or sticking sensation behind the sternum during deglutition. Strongly suggests mucosal inflammation or ulceration of the esophagus.

### **Oesophageal Ulcer**

A mucosal ulceration of the oesophagus caused by gastro-oesophageal reflux, infection, medication or



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corrosive injury, inflammatory disease, or malignancy. It may cause odynophagia, dysphagia, chest pain, haematemesis, or melaena.

### **Oesophagitis**

Inflammation of the oesophageal mucosa. Common causes include gastro-oesophageal reflux, infection in immunocompromised patients, medication-related injury, eosinophilic inflammation, radiation, and caustic ingestion. Symptoms include heartburn, odynophagia, dysphagia, and chest pain.

### **Oestrogen**

The primary female sex hormone, produced mainly by the ovaries (granulosa cells of developing follicles) and in smaller amounts by adipose tissue, the adrenal glands, and the placenta during pregnancy.

### **Oestrogen Replacement Therapy**

The administration of exogenous estrogen (with or without progestogen) to relieve symptoms of estrogen deficiency and prevent long-term health consequences in postmenopausal women. See Hormone Replacement Therapy (HRT).

### **Off-Label Use**

The use of a licensed medication for an indication, dose, route, or patient population not included in its marketing authorisation (product licence).

### **Ogilvie Syndrome**

Acute colonic pseudo-obstruction characterized by massive colonic dilation in the absence of mechanical obstruction typically occurring in hospitalized patients with serious comorbidities including post-surgical states, severe infections, and medication effects.

### **Ogilvie's Syndrome**

Acute colonic pseudo-obstruction characterized by massive dilation of the colon, particularly the cecum and right colon, without mechanical obstruction. It occurs in hospitalized patients with serious medical or surgical conditions, often postoperatively, and results from autonomic nervous system imbalance.

### **Ointment**

A semi-solid, greasy topical preparation for application to the skin, mucous membranes, or eyes. Ointments are typically composed of a hydrophobic base (petrolatum, lanolin, paraffin, beeswax, vegetable oils) and may contain dissolved or suspended active pharmaceutical ingredients.

### **Okihiro Syndrome**

A congenital disorder, usually caused by pathogenic variants in *SALL4*, combining radial-ray limb abnormalities with Duane retraction anomaly or other eye-movement defects. Hearing, cardiac, renal, and vertebral anomalies may also occur.

### **Olfactory Nerve**

Cranial nerve I (CN I), responsible for the sense of smell. Olfactory receptor neurons in the olfactory epithelium of the nasal roof project axons through the cribriform plate of the ethmoid bone to the olfactory bulb, then via the olfactory tract to the primary olfactory cortex (piriform cortex, amygdala, entorhinal cortex).

### **Oligoclonal Bands**

Immunoglobulin G (IgG) proteins produced by a limited number of B-cell clones in the cerebrospinal fluid (CSF), detected by isoelectric focusing of CSF and serum samples.

### **Oligodendroglioma**

A slow-growing glioma arising from oligodendrocytes, most often in the cerebral hemispheres. Associated with IDH mutation and 1p/19q codeletion, which confer a better prognosis and chemosensitivity.

### **Oligohydramnios**

Insufficient amniotic fluid volume, defined as amniotic fluid index less than 5 cm or single deepest pocket less than 2 cm. Causes include fetal renal anomalies, post-term pregnancy, premature rupture of membranes, maternal dehydration, and placental insufficiency.

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## Oligometastasis

A limited number of metastatic deposits, often defined as up to five, amenable to aggressive local treatment (surgery, stereotactic radiation, or ablation) with the potential for prolonged control.

## Oliguria

Reduced urine output, defined as <400 mL/day or <0.5 mL/kg/hour in adults. Oliguria is an important sign of acute kidney injury (AKI) and prerenal azotaemia.

## Olive Pontocerebellar Atrophy

A group of neurodegenerative disorders characterized by progressive loss of neurons in the inferior olives, pons, and cerebellum. They cause worsening ataxia, dysarthria, incoordination, and sometimes pyramidal, autonomic, or cognitive features.

## Omega-3

Polyunsaturated fatty acids (EPA, DHA, ALA). Anti-inflammatory, cardiovascular benefits. Sources: fatty fish, flaxseed, walnuts. Supplementation common.

## Omega-6

Polyunsaturated fatty acids (linoleic acid). Pro-inflammatory in excess. Balance with omega-3 important. Sources: vegetable oils, nuts, seeds.

## Omenn Syndrome

A severe combined immunodeficiency caused by hypomorphic defects affecting lymphocyte-receptor gene rearrangement or related pathways. It presents in infancy with erythroderma, lymphadenopathy, hepatosplenomegaly, diarrhea, failure to thrive, and recurrent or opportunistic infections.

## Omentectomy

Removal of part or all of the greater omentum, commonly performed during staging and cytoreduction for ovarian and other intra-abdominal cancers.

## Omentum

A double layer of peritoneum connecting the stom-

ach to other abdominal organs. The greater omentum (gastrocolic omentum) hangs from the greater curvature of the stomach, covers the transverse colon and small intestine, and is rich in fat and immune cells (milky spots—aggregates of macrophages and lymphocytes).

## Omphalitis

Infection of the umbilical stump in neonates, typically occurring within the first 1–2 weeks of life. Omphalitis is a potentially serious condition requiring prompt treatment due to the risk of spread to the liver (portal vein thrombosis, portal hypertension) and peritoneum via the umbilical vessels.

## Omphalocele

Omphalocele is a congenital abdominal-wall defect in which abdominal organs protrude into a membrane-covered sac at the umbilicus and may coexist with chromosomal or structural anomalies. umbilical cord, covered by a peritoneal-amniotic membrane. Associated with chromosomal abnormalities (trisomies 13, 18) and other anomalies. Differentiated from gastroschisis by membrane coverage and midline location.

## Onchocerca Volvulus

A filarial nematode that causes onchocerciasis (river blindness), transmitted by repeated bites of infected blackflies (*Simulium* species) breeding near fast-flowing rivers. Adult worms reside in subcutaneous nodules (onchocercomata), where they can survive for years, producing microfilariae that migrate through the skin and eyes.

## Onchocerciasis

A parasitic disease caused by the filarial nematode *Onchocerca volvulus*, transmitted by repeated bites of infected blackflies (*Simulium* species) breeding near fast-flowing rivers. Adult worms form subcutaneous nodules (onchocercomata).

## Oncocytoma

A usually benign epithelial tumor, commonly arising in the kidney and composed of cells with abundant eosinophilic mitochondria-rich cytoplasm.

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## **Oncogene**

A gene that, when activated, overexpressed, or altered, can promote uncontrolled cell proliferation or survival. Oncogenes commonly arise from normal proto-oncogenes through mutation, amplification, translocation, or abnormal regulation.

## **Oncogenic**

Capable of promoting the development of cancer.

## **Oncologic Emergency**

A cancer-related condition that threatens life, organ function, or neurologic integrity and requires urgent treatment. Examples include malignant spinal-cord compression, superior vena cava syndrome, tumor lysis syndrome, hypercalcemia, airway obstruction, and febrile neutropenia.

## **Oncologist**

A physician who specializes in the diagnosis and treatment of cancer. Includes medical oncologists (systemic therapy), radiation oncologists (radiotherapy), and surgical oncologists (operative management).

## **Oncology PET**

PET, often combined with CT, used in selected cancers to assess disease distribution, treatment response, or recurrence.

## **Oncology Rehabilitation**

Cancer rehabilitation: fatigue, pain, neuropathy, lymphedema, functional impairment. Pre- and post-treatment support.

## **Oncolytic Virus**

A genetically modified virus that selectively replicates in and destroys cancer cells while sparing normal tissue, e.g., talimogene laherparepvec (T-VEC) for melanoma.

## **Oncosis**

A form of cell death characterized by cellular swelling, derived from the Greek word *onkos* meaning swelling, representing a pre-lethal state that

precedes necrosis. It is typically caused by ischemic injury leading to ATP depletion, which impairs the sodium-potassium pump and causes osmotic water influx.

## **Oncotic Pressure**

The osmotic pressure exerted by plasma proteins (predominantly albumin) that do not freely cross the capillary wall. Normal plasma oncotic pressure is approximately 25–28 mmHg. It opposes the hydrostatic pressure that drives fluid out of capillaries, favoring fluid reabsorption at the venular end.

## **One-Hour Glucose Challenge Test**

A screening test for gestational diabetes mellitus (GDM) performed at 24–28 weeks. The patient drinks 50 g of glucose (regardless of fasting state), and plasma glucose is measured at 1 hour. Thresholds vary by protocol; a result in the range of 130–140 mg/dL positive, warranting diagnostic 3-hour oral glucose tolerance test (OGTT).

## **Onycholysis**

Separation of the nail plate from the underlying nail bed, beginning distally or laterally. Causes include trauma, psoriasis, fungal infection, thyroid disease, medications, and chemical exposure; the underlying cause should be identified.

## **Onychomycosis**

Fungal nail infection, most commonly caused by dermatophytes (*Trichophyton rubrum*), affecting toenails more than fingernails. It presents as nail thickening, discoloration (yellow-brown), subungual debris, and nail separation. Diagnosis is confirmed by KOH preparation or fungal culture.

## **Oocyte**

The female gamete (egg cell) produced in the ovary through oogenesis. Oocytes develop from primordial germ cells, which undergo mitosis to form oogonia, then enter meiosis I before birth and arrest in prophase I until puberty.

## **Oophorectomy**

Surgical removal of one (unilateral) or both (bilat-

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eral) ovaries.

### **Oophoritis**

Inflammation of an ovary, usually associated with pelvic infection or, less commonly, autoimmune disease. It may cause lower abdominal or pelvic pain, fever, abnormal discharge, or menstrual changes; severe pain requires assessment to exclude ovarian torsion or abscess.

### **Opacity**

Lack of transparency of a normally transparent ocular structure (cornea, lens, vitreous, or aqueous humour). Corneal opacity results from scarring (trauma, infection—herpes simplex keratitis, trachoma), dystrophies (Fuchs endothelial dystrophy, granular/lattice/macular dystrophies), or edema.

### **Open Fractures**

Fractures in which the broken bone or fracture hematoma communicates with an external wound. They have increased risks of infection and soft-tissue injury and require urgent assessment and specialized treatment.

### **Open Reduction And Internal Fixation**

Operative exposure and realignment of a fracture followed by fixation with implants such as plates, screws, wires, or nails. It is used when closed treatment cannot provide acceptable alignment, stability, or joint restoration.

### **Open Surgery**

Traditional surgical approach with incision. Used for bypass, aneurysm repair, thrombectomy.

### **Open-Book Fracture**

A pelvic ring disruption with diastasis of the pubic symphysis or sacroiliac joints, often from high-energy trauma, carrying risk of massive hemorrhage and organ injury.

### **Open-Heart Surgery**

Any surgical procedure involving opening the chest wall (sternotomy or thoracotomy) and operating

on the heart, usually with cardiopulmonary bypass (the heart–lung machine).

### **Operative Vaginal Delivery**

Vaginal delivery assisted by vacuum or forceps. Indications: prolonged second stage, suspected fetal compromise, need to shorten the second stage for maternal benefit (exhaustion, cardiac disease, hypertensive crisis).

### **Ophthalmic Emergency**

An eye or visual condition requiring urgent evaluation to prevent irreversible vision loss or severe ocular injury. Examples include acute angle closure, retinal detachment, central retinal artery occlusion, endophthalmitis, chemical injury, orbital cellulitis, and open-globe trauma.

### **Ophthalmomyiasis**

Infestation of the eye by fly larvae (most commonly Oestridae), which may be superficial (conjunctival) or deep (intraocular), with the latter carrying a risk of retinal detachment, endophthalmitis, and permanent vision loss.

### **Ophthalmoplegia**

Weakness or paralysis of one or more eye muscles, causing limited eye movement, double vision, or abnormal eye position. Causes include nerve disorders, stroke, diabetes, thyroid disease, trauma, and neuromuscular conditions.

### **Ophthalmoscope**

Instrument for examining retina and optic nerve. Direct: larger, brighter image. Indirect: wider field. Essential for fundoscopic examination.

### **Ophthalmoscopy**

Ophthalmoscopy examines ophthalmoscopy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. blood vessels, using an ophthalmoscope. It helps detect retinal disease, optic-nerve abnormalities, glaucoma, and systemic vascular disease.

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## Opiate

A natural alkaloid derived from the opium poppy (*Papaver somniferum*) or a semi-synthetic derivative that binds to opioid receptors.

## Opioid Agonist Treatment

Treatment of opioid use disorder with a prescribed opioid agonist or partial agonist, most commonly methadone or buprenorphine, together with psychosocial and medical support. It reduces withdrawal, craving, illicit opioid use, overdose, and mortality.

## Opioid Analgesics

A class of drugs that bind to opioid receptors in the central and peripheral nervous systems, producing analgesia and other effects.

## Opioid Antagonist

A medicine that blocks opioid receptors and can reverse opioid effects such as respiratory depression. Naloxone is a commonly used example.

## Opioid Overdose

A medical emergency characterized by the classic triad of respiratory depression, miosis (pinpoint pupils), and decreased level of consciousness. It can progress to respiratory arrest, cardiovascular collapse, and death.

## Opioid Reversal

Emergency treatment of opioid toxicity with naloxone, a competitive opioid-receptor antagonist. It is titrated to restore adequate breathing, with repeated doses or monitoring sometimes needed because its effect may wear off before the opioid.

## Opioid Toxicity

Toxic effects of opioid agonists, classically respiratory depression, central nervous system depression, and miosis. Management prioritizes ventilation and airway support; naloxone is titrated to restore adequate breathing while recognizing the risk of recurrent toxicity and withdrawal.

## Opioid Use Disorder

A problematic pattern of opioid use leading to significant impairment or distress. Opioids include heroin, fentanyl, morphine, oxycodone, and hydrocodone. Criteria are the same eleven as for substance use disorders generally. Overdose presents with respiratory depression, miosis, and decreased level of consciousness.

## Opioids

A class of drugs that bind to opioid receptors in the central and peripheral nervous systems, producing analgesia and other effects. See Opioid Analgesics.

## Opisthotonos

Opisthotonos is severe backward arching of the head, neck, and spine from sustained muscle spasm, classically associated with tetanus, meningitis, strychnine poisoning, or severe neurologic injury.

## Opportunistic Infection

An infection caused by organisms that ordinarily do not cause disease in immunocompetent hosts but cause significant illness when host defences are impaired.

## Opposition

Movement of the thumb across the palm to contact the fingertips. It combines abduction, flexion, and medial rotation at the first carpometacarpal joint.

## Oppositional Defiant Disorder

A childhood/adolescent disorder characterized by a persistent pattern ( $\geq 6$  months) of angry/irritable mood, argumentative/defiant behavior, and vindictiveness.

## Opsoclonus

Rapid, involuntary, multidirectional, conjugate eye movements without an intersaccadic interval. It may occur with myoclonus and ataxia as part of an autoimmune or paraneoplastic syndrome, particularly in children with neuroblastoma.



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## Opsonization

The process by which pathogens or particles are coated with opsonins (antibodies—IgG, complement—C3b, or acute-phase proteins) that enhance recognition and phagocytosis by phagocytes bearing corresponding receptors (Fc receptors, complement receptors).

## Optic Atrophy

End-stage degeneration of the optic nerve fibers resulting from any optic neuropathy. Causes: glaucoma, ischemic optic neuropathy, multiple sclerosis, compressive lesions (pituitary tumor, aneurysm), toxins (methanol, ethambutol), and hereditary (Leber hereditary optic neuropathy).

## Optic Disc

The point on the retina where the optic nerve exits the eye, lacking photoreceptors and creating the natural blind spot.

## Optic Disc Edema

Swelling of the optic-nerve head caused by axoplasmic-flow disruption. Bilateral optic-disc edema from raised intracranial pressure is papilledema; unilateral or non-pressure causes require separate evaluation for optic-nerve, retinal, inflammatory, ischemic, or infiltrative disease.

## Optic Glioma

A usually slow-growing glioma of the optic nerve or optic pathway, occurring most often in children. It may cause progressive visual loss, optic atrophy, proptosis, or visual-field defects and is associated with neurofibromatosis type 1.

### Synonyms:

Optic Nerve Glioma Optic Pathway Glioma

## Optic Nerve

CN II exiting through the optic disc (blind spot), passing through the optic canal, and partially decussating at the optic chiasm. Technically a CNS tract with oligodendrocyte myelination and meningeal coverings, making it susceptible to demyelinating disease (optic neuritis in MS).

## Optic Nerve Atrophy

Pallor and degeneration of the optic nerve caused by loss of retinal ganglion-cell axons. It produces permanent visual impairment and may result from ischemia, inflammation, compression, glaucoma, trauma, or raised intracranial pressure.

## Optic Neuritis

Inflammation or demyelination of the optic nerve, often causing subacute vision loss, impaired color vision, and pain with eye movement. It may be associated with multiple sclerosis or other inflammatory, infectious, or immune-mediated disorders.

## Optical Coherence Tomography

A non-invasive imaging technique that uses low-coherence interferometry to produce high-resolution, cross-sectional images of the retina and other ocular structures, providing quantitative measurements of retinal layer thickness and detecting structural abnormalities with micrometer-level resolution.

## Optometry

A healthcare profession concerned with examining the eyes and visual system for defects and abnormalities, prescribing corrective lenses (spectacles, contact lenses), diagnosing eye disease, and providing pre- and post-operative care for surgical eye treatments.

## Oral Cancer

Malignancy of oral cavity, including lips, tongue, floor of mouth, buccal mucosa, palate, tonsils, oropharynx. Major risk factors: tobacco use, alcohol consumption, human papillomavirus (HPV, especially p16-positive oropharyngeal cancer). Presentation: persistent ulcer, leukoplakia, erythroplakia, mass, pain, difficulty swallowing.

## Oral Candidiasis

Infection or overgrowth of *Candida* species on the oral mucosa, often presenting as removable white plaques, erythematous patches, or angular cheilitis. Risk factors include antibiotics, inhaled corticosteroids, immunosuppression, diabetes, xerostomia, and dentures.



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## Oral Cavity

The space extending from the lips to the oropharynx, bounded by the cheeks, palate, and tongue. It receives food, begins mechanical and chemical digestion, and contributes to speech.

## Oral Cavity Cancer

Squamous cell carcinoma of the lip, tongue, buccal mucosa, floor of mouth, or palate, associated with tobacco, alcohol, and betel quid use. Treatment is primarily surgical resection, with adjuvant radiation or chemoradiation for adverse features.

## Oral Contraceptive

Birth control pill: combined oral contraceptive (COC—ethinylestradiol + progestin) or progestin-only pill (POP/minipill). Mechanisms: ovulation inhibition, cervical mucus thickening, endometrial change.

## Oral Glucose Tolerance Test

A diagnostic test measuring plasma glucose response after a standardized oral glucose load. It is used in selected evaluations of diabetes, impaired glucose tolerance, and gestational diabetes when fasting glucose or HbA1c is insufficient.

## Oral Hygiene

Practices maintaining oral health: brushing twice daily with fluoride toothpaste, flossing daily, mouthwash (optional), regular dental visits. Proper brushing technique: soft brush, 45-degree angle to gumline, gentle circular motions. Interdental cleaning essential for plaque removal.

## Oral Hypoglycemic

A class of drugs used to treat type 2 diabetes (with lifestyle).

## Oral Leukoplakia

A white patch or plaque on the oral mucosa that cannot be scraped off and cannot be characterized as any other diagnosable disease, considered a potentially malignant disorder. Risk factors: tobacco use (most common), alcohol, and betel nut chewing. Most common sites: buccal mucosa, alveolar ridge,

and tongue.

## Oral Lichen Planus

Chronic inflammatory condition. Reticular (lace-like white lines), erosive (painful ulcers). Associated with hepatitis C. Malignant transformation rare but possible.

### Synonyms:

Lichen Planus, Oral OLP

## Oral Medicine

Specialty diagnosing oral mucosal diseases, dental causes of facial pain, oral manifestations of systemic disease.

## Oral Mucosa

The moist stratified squamous epithelial lining of the oral cavity. It includes masticatory, lining, and specialized mucosa and provides barrier protection, sensation, lubrication, and sites for minor salivary glands.

## Oral Nutritional Supplement

A calorie-, protein-, or micronutrient-containing product consumed by mouth to supplement, not automatically replace, usual food intake. The product and dose should match the patient's needs, swallowing ability, disease restrictions, and tolerance.

## Oral Pathology

Study of diseases affecting oral tissues. Includes neoplasms, cysts, inflammatory conditions, developmental anomalies.

## Oral Polio Vaccine

A live attenuated poliovirus vaccine administered by mouth. Its formulation and use depend on the public-health program and circulating poliovirus strains; it has played an important role in polio control.

## Oral Radiology

Specialty of producing and interpreting images of oral and maxillofacial region.

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### Oral Sex (Fellatio, Cunnilingus)

Oral stimulation of the genitals for sexual pleasure. Fellatio: oral stimulation of the penis. Cunnilingus: oral stimulation of the vulva and clitoris. Analingus (rimming): oral stimulation of the anus.

#### Synonyms:

Fellatio, Cunnilingus

### Oral Squamous Cell Carcinoma

A malignant neoplasm arising from oral stratified squamous epithelium. Persistent induration, ulceration, red or white patches, unexplained bleeding, pain, or neck mass requires evaluation and biopsy; staging incorporates tumor, nodal, and metastatic findings.

### Oral Surgery

Surgical procedures in oral and maxillofacial region. Extractions, implant placement, biopsies, cyst removal, corrective jaw surgery.

### Oral Toxicity

Harm caused by swallowing a toxic substance, medicine, or excessive dose.

### Oral Ulcer

Ulceration of oral mucosa. Aphthous ulcer (canker sore) most common. Traumatic, viral, autoimmune causes.

### Orbital Cellulitis

A serious infection of the orbital tissues posterior to the orbital septum, potentially sight-threatening and life-threatening due to the risk of optic nerve compression, cavernous sinus thrombosis, and intracranial extension.

### Orbital Metastasis

Secondary cancer deposits in the orbit, most commonly from breast, lung, or prostate primaries. Symptoms include proptosis, diplopia, pain, and visual impairment.

### Orbital Pseudotumor

Noninfectious, idiopathic inflammation of orbital

tissues, also called idiopathic orbital inflammation. It can cause painful eye movement, proptosis, eyelid swelling, diplopia, and restricted ocular motility.

#### Synonyms:

idiopathic.

### Orchiectomy

Surgical removal of one or both testicles. Radical inguinal orchiectomy is diagnostic and therapeutic for testicular cancer; bilateral orchiectomy is a hormonal therapy for prostate cancer.

### Orchitis

Orchitis is inflammation of one or both testes, often from infection such as mumps or bacteria, causing pain, swelling, and sometimes impaired fertility.

### Orexin Receptor Antagonists

Medications that block orexin (hypocretin) receptors to promote sleep. Suvorexant and lemborexant are approved for insomnia. They reduce wakefulness by blocking the arousal system. They have lower abuse potential than benzodiazepines and do not cause respiratory depression.

### Orf

A zoonotic viral skin infection caused by the parapoxvirus, transmitted to humans from infected sheep and goats (direct contact with lesions, fomites—virus survives in scabs for months). Orf is an occupational disease of farmers, butchers, and veterinarians. Incubation: 3–7 days.

### Organ

A structure composed of two or more different types of tissues that has a recognizable shape and performs specific functions.

### Organ System

A group of related organs that work together to perform major body functions.

### Organ Transplants

The surgical transfer of an organ from a donor to a recipient whose organ function is severely impaired.

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Solid-organ transplantation may involve the kidney, liver, heart, lung, pancreas, or intestine and requires donor assessment, recipient selection, and ongoing follow-up.

### **Organophosphate**

A class of chemicals that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase. Some are pesticides or nerve agents and can cause cholinergic poisoning.

### **Organophosphate Poisoning**

Acetylcholinesterase inhibitors. SLUDGE syndrome: salivation, lacrimation, urination, defecation, GI upset, emesis. Miosis, bradycardia, bronchospasm, muscle fasciculations. Treatment: atropine, pralidoxime, supportive care.

### **Orogastric Tube**

Tube through mouth to stomach. For infants, unconscious patients.

### **Oropharyngeal Airway**

A rigid airway adjunct inserted through the mouth to displace the tongue and help maintain upper-airway patency in an unconscious patient without an intact gag reflex. It does not protect against aspiration.

### **Oropharyngeal Carcinoma**

Malignancy arising in the oropharynx, including the tonsil, base of tongue, soft palate, and posterior pharyngeal wall. HPV-associated tumors form an important subgroup; evaluation includes endoscopy, biopsy, imaging, and cervical-node assessment.

### **Oropharynx**

The posterior portion of the mouth leading to the esophagus, containing the tonsils and base of tongue. Area for swallowing and speech. Examination with tongue depressor and light source. Pathology: pharyngitis, tonsillitis, malignancy.

### **Orphan Drug**

A pharmaceutical agent developed specifically to treat a rare medical condition (affecting fewer than

200,000 people in the United States, as defined by the Orphan Drug Act of 1983).

### **Orthodontic Bracket**

A bonded or banded attachment that transmits forces from an orthodontic archwire to a tooth. Bracket position and wire sequence guide controlled tooth movement.

### **Orthodontic Retainer**

A removable or fixed appliance used after active orthodontic treatment to maintain tooth position while periodontal and alveolar tissues remodel. Retention is often needed long term because relapse can occur.

### **Orthodontics**

Specialty of dental management of malocclusion and dental-facial discrepancies. Appliances: fixed braces, removable appliances, clear aligners. Treatment indications: crowding, spacing, overbite, underbite, crossbite, open bite, midline discrepancy. Treatment duration: 12-24 months typically. Retention phase essential for stability.

### **Orthognathic Surgery**

Corrective jaw surgery for skeletal malocclusion. Le Fort I, Bilateral Sagittal Split Osteotomy. Combined with orthodontics.

### **Orthopedic Biologics**

Biological or biomaterial products used to support bone or soft-tissue healing. Examples include autograft, allograft, demineralized bone matrix, bone-marrow products, and synthetic graft substitutes; their uses and evidence vary by procedure and condition.

### **Orthopedic Implant**

Devices for bone/joint reconstruction. Types: plates, screws, rods, hinges, prostheses. Materials: titanium, cobalt-chrome, stainless steel, polyethylene, ceramic. Used for fractures, arthritis, tumors, deformities. Complications: infection, loosening, fracture, wear.

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## Orthopedic Infections

Infections involving bones, joints, muscles, or orthopedic implants. Examples include osteomyelitis, septic arthritis, prosthetic-joint infection, and some diabetic foot infections.

## Orthopedic Rehabilitation

Therapy that restores movement, strength, function, and independence after musculoskeletal injury or surgery.

## Orthopedic Screws

Fixation devices for fractures. Materials: titanium, stainless steel. Types: cortical, cancellous, interfragmentary. Used with plates, rods, nails. Complications: loosening, breakage, infection.

## Orthopedics

The branch of surgery concerned with the musculoskeletal system, including bones, joints, ligaments, tendons, muscles, and nerves.

## Orthopnea

Dyspnea that occurs when lying flat and is relieved by sitting upright. It is measured by the number of pillows the patient needs to sleep (two-pillow orthopnea). It is a hallmark of left heart failure and is caused by redistribution of fluid from the lower extremities to the lungs in the supine position.

## Orthopnoea

Shortness of breath that occurs when lying flat and is relieved by sitting or standing upright. Orthopnoea is a classic symptom of left-sided heart failure (elevated pulmonary venous pressure worsens pulmonary congestion in the supine position). Other causes: severe COPD, asthma exacerbation, diaphragmatic paralysis, ascites, and obesity.

## Orthorexia

A term used for an excessive or rigid preoccupation with eating foods considered healthy. It is not a universally recognized formal psychiatric diagnosis but may cause nutritional or social impairment.

## Orthosis

An externally applied device that supports, aligns, prevents deformity, protects, or assists movement of a body segment. It differs from a prosthesis, which replaces a missing body part.

## Orthostatic Hypotension

Decrease in SBP  $\geq 20$  mmHg or DBP  $\geq 10$  mmHg within 3 minutes of standing. Causes: dehydration, medications (antihypertensives, diuretics, alpha-blockers, antidepressants), autonomic dysfunction (diabetes, Parkinson disease), and prolonged bed rest. Symptoms: dizziness, lightheadedness, syncope, falls.

## Orthostatic Intolerance

Symptoms or signs that develop when standing because the cardiovascular and autonomic systems do not maintain adequate cerebral perfusion. Manifestations include light-headedness, palpitations, fatigue, visual dimming, presyncope, or syncope and may occur with or without orthostatic tachycardia or hypotension.

## Orthotic Training

Training for brace users: donning/doffing, skin care, gait training with brace.

## Osborn Wave

A positive deflection at the junction of the QRS complex and ST segment on electrocardiography, also known as a J wave. It is classically associated with hypothermia, where its amplitude correlates with the degree of cooling.

### Synonyms:

a J wave.

## OSFED

Other Specified Feeding or Eating Disorder, used when the clinical presentation causes significant distress or impairment but does not meet full criteria for any of the specific eating disorders.

## Osgood-Schlatter Disease

A traction apophysitis of the tibial tuberosity at the

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insertion of the patellar tendon, caused by repetitive microtrauma during periods of rapid growth.

### Osler Nodes

Painful, erythematous nodules on the pads of fingers and toes, caused by immune complex deposition in infective endocarditis. They are a minor criterion in the Duke criteria. Osler nodes are tender and may last hours to days.

### Osmolality

The concentration of osmotically active particles per kilogram of solvent. Plasma osmolality is determined mainly by sodium and its accompanying anions, glucose, and urea and governs water movement across cell membranes.

### Osmosis

The net movement of water molecules across a semipermeable membrane from a region of lower solute concentration (higher water concentration) to a region of higher solute concentration (lower water concentration). Driven by the osmotic pressure difference, which is proportional to the number of solute particles.

### Osmotic Demyelination Syndrome

Demyelinating process affecting the pons and extrapontine regions caused by overly rapid correction of chronic hyponatremia. The brain adapts to chronic hyponatremia by extruding osmoles and when sodium is corrected too quickly water shifts out of brain cells causing osmotic injury to oligodendrocytes.

### Osmotic Diarrhea

Diarrhea caused by poorly absorbed solutes retaining water in the intestinal lumen. It typically improves with fasting and may result from carbohydrate malabsorption, laxatives, or other osmotically active substances.

### Osmotic Fragility Test

A test that measures the susceptibility of red blood cells to haemolysis when placed in progressively more dilute saline solutions. Increased fragility sup-

ports hereditary spherocytosis, although the result may also be affected by other haemolytic disorders and recent transfusion.

### Osmotic Pressure

The pressure required to prevent the movement of water across a semipermeable membrane when a solute concentration gradient exists, proportional to the number of dissolved particles (van't Hoff law:  $\pi = iCRT$ ). It is a colligative property depending on particle number, not particle identity.

### Osseointegration

Direct structural and functional connection between living bone and the surface of a load-bearing implant under appropriate conditions. It depends on implant stability, surface characteristics, bone quality, healing, and control of infection and occlusal forces.

### Ossicles

Three smallest body bones forming the ossicular chain in the middle ear: malleus (hammer, attached to tympanic membrane), incus (anvil), stapes (stirrup, footplate in oval window).

### Ossicular Discontinuity

Partial or complete separation of the middle-ear ossicles, usually caused by trauma, chronic ear disease, or surgery. It produces conductive hearing loss and may be evaluated with otoscopy, audiometry, and imaging.

#### Synonyms:

Ossicular-chain discontinuity; ossicular disruption.

### Osteoarthritis

Osteoarthritis is a degenerative joint disorder involving cartilage loss, subchondral bone change, pain, stiffness, and functional limitation, influenced by age, injury, and joint loading. bone sclerosis, osteophyte formation, and synovial inflammation, affecting knees, hips, hands (DIP/PIP Heberden/Bouchard nodes), spine. Risk factors: age, obesity, joint injury, malalignment, genetics, female sex.

#### Synonyms:

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Arthritis Degenerative (Osteoarthritis) Degenerative Arthritis

### **Osteoarthritis (Geriatric)**

Osteoarthritis occurring in later life, commonly affecting the knees, hips, hands, or spine and causing joint pain, stiffness, and reduced movement. Management may include exercise, weight management, medicines, assistive measures, or joint replacement when appropriate.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Osteoblast**

A bone-forming cell derived from mesenchymal stem cells in the bone marrow. Osteoblasts synthesise and deposit the bone matrix (osteoid), composed primarily of type I collagen and non-collagenous proteins (osteocalcin, osteonectin, alkaline phosphatase).

### **Osteochondritis Dissecans**

A condition characterized by separation of a fragment of articular cartilage and subchondral bone from the joint surface, most commonly in the knee (lateral aspect of the medial femoral condyle). Most common in adolescents and young adults. Etiology: repetitive microtrauma, ischemia, or genetic predisposition.

### **Osteochondroma**

A usually benign cartilage-capped bony projection arising from the surface of a bone and continuous with its cortex and medullary cavity. It may be solitary or occur in hereditary multiple exostoses.

### **Osteoclast**

A large, multinucleated bone-resorbing cell derived from the monocyte–macrophage lineage (hematopoietic stem cells).

### **Osteocyte**

The mature, terminally differentiated bone cell embedded within the bone matrix in lacunae, derived from osteoblasts. Osteocytes are connected to each other and to bone surface cells via canaliculi, forming a mechanosensory network that senses mechan-

ical loading and fluid flow.

### **Osteogenesis Imperfecta**

A connective tissue disorder caused by collagen type I mutations, ranging from mild to lethal. Features: fractures with minimal trauma, blue sclerae, dental abnormalities, and hearing loss. Severe forms (type II) cause multiple fractures in utero and perinatal death. Diagnosis: clinical features, genetic testing, and bone biopsy.

### **Osteoid Osteoma**

A benign bone-forming tumor, usually in an adolescent or young adult, characterized by a small vascular nidus surrounded by reactive sclerosis. It commonly causes localized pain that is worse at night and may improve with nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs.

### **Osteomalacia**

Osteomalacia is inadequate mineralization of adult bone, commonly from vitamin-D deficiency or phosphate disorders, causing bone pain, weakness, and fractures.

### **Osteomyelitis**

Osteomyelitis is infection and inflammation of bone caused by bacteria, fungi, or other organisms, producing pain, fever, swelling, and possible bone destruction or chronic drainage. *Staphylococcus aureus* responsible for the majority of cases.

### **Osteonecrosis (Avascular Necrosis)**

Osteonecrosis (AVN) is bone death from vascular compromise, affecting femoral head (most common), humeral head, femoral condyles, talus. Risk factors: glucocorticoids (high dose, cumulative), alcohol, trauma, sickle cell disease, SLE, antiphospholipid syndrome, pancreatitis, decompression sickness, radiation, organ transplantation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Avascular Necrosis

### **Osteopathy**

A system of manual medicine and healthcare founded by Andrew Taylor Still (1828–1917) based



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on the principle that the body's structure (musculoskeletal system) and function are interrelated, and that the body has inherent self-regulatory and healing mechanisms.

### **Osteopenia**

Bone mineral density (BMD) that is lower than normal but not low enough to be classified as osteoporosis. T-score between -1.0 and -2.5 on DXA scan. A risk factor for osteoporosis and fractures.

### **Osteopetrosis**

A rare inherited bone disease characterized by defective osteoclast function, leading to impaired bone resorption and abnormally dense, sclerotic bones. The bone is structurally abnormal—brittle despite increased density—and prone to fracture.

### **Osteoporosis**

Osteoporosis is reduced bone strength from low bone mass or impaired bone quality, increasing risk of fragility fractures of the spine, hip, wrist, and other bones. medicines, genetics, nutrition, smoking, alcohol, and other conditions; diagnosis and management use clinical assessment and bone-density testing when appropriate.

### **Osteoporosis Fracture Risk Assessment**

Evaluation combining clinical risk factors, prior fragility fracture history, bone mineral density, and tools such as FRAX to estimate future fracture probability and guide treatment.

### **Osteosarcoma**

Osteosarcoma is an aggressive malignant bone tumor that produces osteoid, most often affecting the metaphysis of long bones in children and young adults. leukemia), with a peak incidence during the adolescent growth spurt (ages 10-20 years), and a second smaller peak in older adults (usually secondary to Paget disease or prior radiation).

### **Osteotomy**

A surgical procedure involving cutting and repositioning of bone to correct deformity, realign joint surfaces, alter weight-bearing forces, or change limb

length.

### **Ostomy**

Surgical opening into bowel or urinary tract. Colostomy, ileostomy, urostomy. Appliances for collection.

### **Ostomy Appliance**

Collection device for feces/urine after ostomy surgery. Types: urostomy (urine), colostomy (feces), ileostomy (ileum). One-piece or two-piece systems. Open or closed end. Skin care essential.

### **Ostraceous Psoriasis**

A severe, chronic variant of plaque psoriasis in which the lesions become thick, hard, and shell-like (ostraceous), with laminated, greyish-brown crusts resembling oyster shells. It is often refractory to standard therapies and may require systemic agents, biologics, or combination treatment.

### **Other Pain Conditions**

Pain conditions that do not fit neatly into a single category, including nociplastic pain, fibromyalgia, chronic tension-type headache, temporomandibular pain, chronic pelvic pain, and complex regional pain syndrome. Diagnosis and treatment depend on the specific condition.

### **Other Specified Sexual Dysfunction**

A category for sexual dysfunction symptoms that cause distress but do not meet full criteria for any specific sexual dysfunction.

### **Otic Capsule**

The otic capsule is the dense bony shell (otic capsule bone) that surrounds and protects the inner ear structures, including the cochlea, vestibule, and semicircular canals, forming the hardest bone in the human body.

### **Otitis Media With Effusion**

Nonpurulent fluid in the middle ear without acute signs of infection. It may cause conductive hearing loss, aural fullness, or speech and learning effects

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in children; many cases resolve spontaneously, but persistent or consequential effusion requires hearing assessment and ENT review.

### Otocephaly

A severe congenital craniofacial malformation characterized by absent or markedly underdeveloped mandible, ventral displacement or fusion of the ears, and associated facial and airway abnormalities. It is usually lethal because of profound impairment of breathing and feeding.

### Otorrhea

Discharge from the ear. Classification: acute otorrhea (<6 weeks) and chronic otorrhea (>6 weeks).

### Otoacoustic Emissions

Low-level sounds generated by the cochlea, usually by outer hair cells, that can be recorded with a sensitive probe in the ear canal. Testing is used for newborn hearing screening and for assessing cochlear function.

#### Synonyms:

OAE; otoacoustic-emission testing; cochlear emissions.

### Ototoxicity

Functional damage to the cochlea or vestibular system caused by exposure to a toxic substance, including some medicines or industrial chemicals. It may present with hearing loss, tinnitus, or imbalance and can be temporary or permanent.

#### Synonyms:

Auditory toxicity; vestibular toxicity; ototoxic effect.

### Outcome Measurement

The use of defined measures to assess a patient's symptoms, function, quality of life, or other results before and after care.

### Outcome Research

Study of rehabilitation outcomes. Effectiveness, cost-effectiveness, patient-reported outcomes.

### Outer Ear

The visible auricle and the external auditory canal, which collect and conduct sound toward the eardrum.

### Outpatient Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided without hospital admission to improve function after illness, injury, surgery, or disability. The setting, frequency, and duration are individualized.

### Ovarian Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the ovary or related tissues. It may cause abdominal or pelvic symptoms, but early disease can be asymptomatic.

#### Synonyms:

Cancer, Ovarian

### Ovarian Cyst

A fluid-filled sac within or on the ovary, most commonly functional (follicular or corpus luteum cysts) related to the menstrual cycle. Usually asymptomatic; can present with pelvic pain, pressure, and bloating. Complications: rupture, hemorrhage, torsion (sudden severe pain with nausea/vomiting).

### Ovarian Hyperstimulation Syndrome

A potentially serious complication of ovarian stimulation in assisted reproduction caused by increased vascular permeability and fluid shift. It produces enlarged ovaries, abdominal distension, ascites, hemoconcentration, electrolyte abnormalities, thrombosis risk, and, in severe cases, organ dysfunction.

#### Synonyms:

OHSS

### Ovarian Pregnancy

A rare ectopic pregnancy implanted in ovarian tissue rather than in the uterine cavity or fallopian tube. Diagnosis uses clinical findings, serial human chorionic gonadotropin measurements, ultrasound, and sometimes surgical or pathologic confirmation; treatment is individualized.

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## Ovarian Torsion

Twisting of the ovary (and often the fallopian tube) on its vascular pedicle, causing obstruction of blood flow—a gynecologic emergency. Risk: ovarian cysts/tumors (especially >5 cm), longer utero-ovarian ligament, younger women, pregnancy.

## Over-The-Counter

Medications available without a prescription, considered safe and effective for self-care with appropriate labeling and low abuse potential. Examples: acetaminophen, ibuprofen, antacids, antihistamines, decongestants, laxatives. Regulated in the US by the FDA (OTC monograph system) and Rx-to-OTC switches (e.g., omeprazole, loratadine).

## Over-The-Counter Medications

Nonprescription drugs approved as safe and effective for self-management of common symptoms, available at pharmacies and retail stores without a prescription.

## Over-The-Counter Drug

A medication that can be purchased without a prescription, deemed safe and effective for self-medication when used according to label instructions. OTC drugs have established safety profiles, low toxicity, and clear dosing guidelines suitable for consumer use.

## Overactive Bladder

A clinical syndrome of urinary urgency, usually with frequency and nocturia, with or without urge incontinence, due to detrusor overactivity during filling. Causes: idiopathic (most), neurogenic (stroke, spinal injury, MS, Parkinson), bladder outlet obstruction, and aging; worsened by caffeine and diuretics.

### Synonyms:

OAB OAB (Overactive Bladder)

## Overall Survival

Time from treatment to death from any cause.

## Overdenture

Removable denture supported by implants or natural teeth. Preservation of alveolar bone, improved stability.

## Overflow Urinary Incontinence

Leakage of urine caused by incomplete bladder emptying and excessive bladder filling. It may occur with weak urinary flow, dribbling, urgency, or urinary retention.

## Overgrowth Syndrome

A group of congenital disorders characterized by excessive growth of the body, a region, or specific tissues, often with developmental or tumor-predisposition features. Causes include genomic imprinting abnormalities, mosaic variants, and alterations in growth-signaling pathways.

## Overlap Myositis

Patients with features of inflammatory myopathy (DM/PM/IMNM) plus another systemic autoimmune disease (SLE, SSc, MCTD, Sjogren). Anti-PM-Scl (Scl/PM overlap, limited SSc + myositis, good prognosis); anti-Ku (SLE/PM overlap); anti-U1-RNP (MCTD with myositis).

## Oxaloacetate

A four-carbon citric-acid-cycle intermediate that condenses with acetyl-CoA to form citrate. It is also a precursor for gluconeogenesis and participates in amino-acid transamination to aspartate.

## Oxidative Phosphorylation

Process generating ATP using energy released by electron transfer through the electron transport chain. Protons pumped across inner mitochondrial membrane create electrochemical gradient (proton motive force). ATP synthase (Complex V) uses proton flow to phosphorylate ADP to ATP. P/O ratio: 2.5 ATP per NADH, 1.5 ATP per FADH<sub>2</sub>.

## Oxidative Stress

Imbalance between reactive oxygen species and antioxidants. DNA damage, protein oxidation, lipid peroxidation.

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## Oxygen Consumption

The volume of oxygen consumed by the body per unit time, reflecting overall metabolic rate. Resting oxygen consumption (VO<sub>2</sub>) in a normal adult is approximately 250 mL/min (about 3.5 mL/kg/min, 1 MET). It is calculated as cardiac output x (arterial O<sub>2</sub> content - venous O<sub>2</sub> content) by the Fick principle.

## Oxygen Delivery

The rate at which oxygen is transported from the lungs to the tissues, equal to cardiac output multiplied by arterial oxygen content:  $DO_2 = CO \times CaO_2$ . Arterial oxygen content =  $(1.34 \times \text{hemoglobin} \times SaO_2) + (0.003 \times PaO_2)$ . Normal oxygen delivery is approximately 1000 mL/min.

## Oxygen Enhancement Ratio

Ratio of dose under hypoxic vs. aerobic conditions. Higher for low LET radiation.

## Oxygen Mask

Delivers supplemental oxygen. Types: simple, nasal cannula, non-rebreather, Venturi.

## Oxygen Saturation

The percentage of hemoglobin carrying oxygen in blood. It may be estimated by pulse oximetry (SpO<sub>2</sub>) or measured in an arterial blood sample by co-oximetry (SaO<sub>2</sub>). The appropriate range depends on the person's condition, baseline oxygenation, and treatment goals.

## Oxygen-Hemoglobin Dissociation Curve

The sigmoidal relationship between partial pressure of oxygen (PO<sub>2</sub>) and hemoglobin oxygen saturation (SO<sub>2</sub>). The curve reflects hemoglobin's cooperative binding: oxygen binding to one subunit increases affinity for subsequent oxygen molecules. At PO<sub>2</sub> of 100 mmHg (alveolar), hemoglobin is approximately 98 percent saturated.

## Oxytocics

A class of medications that stimulate uterine contractions, used for induction and augmentation of labor and prevention/treatment of postpartum hem-

orrhage. Oxytocin (Syntocinon) — synthetic analog of endogenous oxytocin, administered IV infusion for labor induction or IM/IV for PPH prevention.

## Oxytocin Infusion

Intravenous synthetic oxytocin used to induce or augment labor or, in selected settings, to manage postpartum bleeding. The dose is started and adjusted according to uterine activity, fetal status, maternal condition, and local protocol; excessive uterine stimulation can be harmful.

## Ozaena

A chronic condition characterized by atrophic rhinitis with crusting, foul-smelling nasal discharge (fetor), and a sensation of nasal obstruction despite a patent airway. Ozaena is caused by progressive atrophy of the nasal mucosa and underlying bone, often associated with *Klebsiella ozaenae* infection.

## Ondine's Curse

A rare disorder in which automatic breathing is impaired, especially during sleep; also called congenital central hypoventilation syndrome.

### Synonyms:

congenital central hypoventilation syndrome.

## Open Prostatectomy

Surgical removal of enlarged prostate tissue through an abdominal incision.

## Orbital Irradiation

Radiation treatment directed at tissues within the eye socket, sometimes used for severe thyroid eye disease.

## Overt Proteinuria

Abnormally high protein loss in the urine that is detectable by routine testing and may indicate kidney disease.

## Obstructive Hydrocephalus

A buildup of cerebrospinal fluid caused by a blockage in its normal flow through the brain's ventricles.

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### **Ocular Melanoma**

A cancer that begins in pigment-producing cells of the eye.

### **Odontogenic Cyst**

A fluid-filled sac that develops from tissues involved in tooth formation, usually in the jaw.

### **Oblique Fracture**

A fracture in which the break crosses the bone at an angle rather than perpendicular or parallel to its long axis.

### **Occlusive Vascular Disease**

Disease in which narrowing or blockage of a blood vessel reduces or stops blood flow to tissues.

### **Olfaction**

The sense of smell, mediated by receptors in the olfactory epithelium and pathways to the brain.

### **Orifice**

An opening into or out of a body structure, organ, or anatomical passage.

### **Osteochondrosis**

A disorder of bone and cartilage development, often affecting a growth center or joint surface.

### **Osteodystrophy**

Abnormal bone growth or remodeling caused by a systemic or metabolic disorder.

### **Osteogenic Sarcoma**

Osteosarcoma, a malignant bone tumor whose cells produce osteoid or immature bone.

### **Osteoplasty**

Surgical repair, reshaping, or reconstruction of bone.

### **Otorhinolaryngology**

The medical specialty concerned with diseases of the ear, nose, throat, head, and neck; also called otolaryngology.

### **Synonyms:**

otolaryngology.

### **Ocular Rosacea**

Inflammation affecting the eyes and eyelids in people with rosacea, causing irritation, redness, or dryness.

### **Ophthalmia Neonatorum**

Eye inflammation or infection in a newborn, often acquired during delivery.

### **Optic Disk**

The point where the optic nerve leaves the retina; it has no photoreceptors and forms the blind spot.

### **Orthopneic Position**

An upright sitting position that helps a person breathe more easily, often with the arms supported.

### **Osteotome**

A sharp surgical instrument used to cut or shape bone.

### **Oculomotor Nerve Palsy**

Weakness or paralysis of muscles supplied by the third cranial nerve, causing eyelid drooping, double vision, abnormal eye position, and sometimes a dilated pupil.

### **Open-Angle Glaucoma**

A chronic optic-nerve disease in which the drainage angle of the eye remains anatomically open but aqueous humour outflow is impaired, often causing progressive, initially symptomless visual-field loss.

### **Onychocryptosis (Ingrowing Toenail)**

A condition in which the edge of a nail grows into the surrounding skin, causing pain, inflammation, and sometimes infection.

### **Synonyms:**

Ingrowing Toenail

### **Oral Rehydration Therapy (ORT)**

Replacement of water and electrolytes by mouth using a balanced glucose-and-salt solution, especially

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to prevent or treat dehydration from diarrhoea or vomiting.

**Synonyms:**  
ORT

### **Ortolani's Sign**

A palpable or audible clunk produced when a dislocated but reducible infant hip is gently abducted and reduced; it is a screening sign of developmental dysplasia of the hip.

### **Otalgia (Earache)**

Pain in or around the ear, arising from the ear itself or referred from structures such as the teeth, jaw, throat, or cervical spine.

**Synonyms:**  
Earache

### **Otolith**

A small calcium-carbonate crystal in the vestibular organs of the inner ear that contributes to sensing gravity and linear acceleration; displaced otoliths can cause benign positional vertigo.

### **Ocular Migraine**

A migraine-related visual disturbance, often involving flashing lights, zigzag lines, or a temporary blind spot. It may occur with or without headache.

### **Orbital Fracture**

A break in one or more bones forming the eye socket, usually caused by facial trauma and potentially associated with double vision, eye-movement restriction, or injury to the eye.

### **Osteonecrosis Of The Jaw**

Death of jawbone tissue, often associated with antiresorptive or antiangiogenic medications, radiation, infection, or trauma, and characterized by exposed bone or a nonhealing oral wound.

### **Opioid Withdrawal**

A characteristic group of symptoms occurring after abrupt reduction or cessation of prolonged opioid use, including anxiety, muscle aches, sweating, ab-

dominal cramps, diarrhea, nausea, and insomnia.

### **Oropharyngeal Dysphagia**

Difficulty transferring food or liquid from the mouth through the throat, often causing coughing, choking, nasal regurgitation, or aspiration.

### **Oxygen Toxicity**

Tissue injury caused by exposure to oxygen at excessively high partial pressures or concentrations, potentially affecting the lungs, eyes, or central nervous system.

### **Obstetric Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the birth canal and the bladder or rectum, usually caused by prolonged obstructed labor, resulting in continuous leakage of urine or stool. It requires specialist evaluation and repair.

### **Obatoclox**

A medical term referring to obatoclox. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Obatoclox Mesylate**

A medical term referring to obatoclox mesylate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oblimersen Sodium**

Oblimersen sodium is an investigational antisense drug designed to reduce BCL-2 protein expression and increase cancer-cell sensitivity to treatment.

### **Observational Study**

observational study is a developmental, reproductive, family, or study-design term describing how a person, embryo, pregnancy, or research subject is classified or observed.

### **Obstetric Nursing**

Obstetric nursing provides care during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postpartum period, including monitoring, education, support, and recognition of complications.



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### **Obstetrical Forceps**

A medical term referring to obstetrical forceps. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Occipital Diastasis**

Occipital diastasis is separation or widening of an occipital skull suture, usually related to birth trauma or developmental abnormality and assessed with imaging.

### **Occlusal Adjustment**

A medical term referring to occlusal adjustment. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Occlusal Splint**

A medical term referring to occlusal splint. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ochrobactrum**

A biomedical term referring to ochrobactrum; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Ochrobactrum Anthropi**

A biomedical term referring to ochrobactrum anthropi; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Ochrobactrum Intermedium**

A biomedical term referring to ochrobactrum intermedium; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Octadecadienoic Acid**

octadecadienoic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Octanoic Acid**

octanoic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Octopamine**

A medical term referring to octopamine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Octreotide**

Octreotide is a somatostatin analogue that suppresses growth hormone, several gastrointestinal hormones, and intestinal secretion; it is used for acromegaly, certain neuroendocrine tumors, and selected secretory diarrhoeas.

### **Ocular Albinism**

Ocular albinism is an inherited disorder with reduced pigment primarily in the eyes, causing decreased visual acuity, nystagmus, photophobia, and abnormal retinal development.

### **Ocular Fixation**

A biological or biochemical term involving ocular fixation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ocular Orbit**

The ocular orbit is the bony cavity containing the eye, extraocular muscles, nerves, vessels, glands, and protective connective tissue.

### **Ocular Toxoplasmosis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving ocular toxoplasmosis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Oculocardiac Reflex**

The oculocardiac reflex is slowing of the heart or other vagal responses triggered by pressure or traction on the eye or orbital tissues.

### **Oculomotor Nucleus**

The oculomotor nucleus is a midbrain group of mo-

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tor neurons controlling most eye movements, eyelid elevation, and pupil constriction through the third cranial nerve.

### **Odontodysplasia**

Odontodysplasia is abnormal development of tooth enamel and dentin, producing thin, weak, discolored teeth that may erupt late or be easily damaged.

### **Odontogenic Fibroma**

An odontogenic fibroma is a rare benign tumor arising from tooth-forming connective tissue, usually presenting as a jaw lesion.

### **Odontogenic Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving odontogenic neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Odorant**

An odorant is a chemical molecule detected by olfactory receptors and perceived as a smell.

### **Odoribacter Splanchnicus**

odoribacter splanchnicus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Oerskovia**

A biomedical term referring to oerskovia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Oerskovia Turbata**

A biomedical term referring to oerskovia turbata; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Ofatumumab**

A medical term referring to ofatumumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Offspring**

Offspring are the descendants or young produced by an organism or pair of organisms.

### **Oidiodendron**

oidiodendron is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Ointment Bases**

A medical term referring to ointment bases. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Okadaic Acid**

okadaic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Olanzapine**

Olanzapine is an atypical antipsychotic that blocks dopamine and serotonin receptors and treats schizophrenia and bipolar disorder; weight gain, diabetes, dyslipidaemia, sedation, and movement disorders are important risks.

### **Olaparib**

Olaparib is a PARP inhibitor used for selected cancers with BRCA or other homologous-recombination repair defects; anaemia, nausea, fatigue, myelosuppression, and rare myelodysplastic syndrome or acute myeloid leukaemia may occur.

### **Olaratumab**

A medical term referring to olaratumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oleandomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oleandomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

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## Olfactory Bulb

The olfactory bulb is a forebrain structure that receives signals from nasal smell receptors and begins processing odor information.

## Olfactory Cortex

The olfactory cortex is a group of brain regions that interprets smell signals and links them with memory, emotion, and behavior.

## Olfactory Gyrus

The olfactory gyrus is a cortical region associated with processing olfactory information and includes areas near the medial temporal and frontal lobes.

## Olfactory Learning

Olfactory learning is acquisition or modification of behavior or memory through exposure to odors and their associations.

## Olfactory Mucosa

The olfactory mucosa is specialized nasal lining containing receptor neurons, supporting cells, and glands that detect odor molecules.

## Olfactory Neuroblastoma

A medical term referring to olfactory neuroblastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Olfactory Tract

The olfactory tract is a bundle of nerve fibers carrying smell information from the olfactory bulb to cerebral regions involved in odor perception.

## Olfactory Tubercle

The olfactory tubercle is a ventral forebrain region involved in odor processing, reward, motivation, and integration with limbic circuits.

## Oligella

oligella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

## Oligella Ureolytica

A biomedical term referring to oligella ureolytica; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Oligella Urethralis

A biomedical term referring to oligella urethralis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Oligodendroglia

Oligodendroglia are glial cells of the central nervous system that produce myelin around axons and support nerve conduction.

## Oligodendroglial Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving oligodendroglial neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Oligogenic Inheritance

Oligogenic inheritance occurs when variants in a small number of genes together influence a trait or disease, often with variable expression.

## Oligomenorrhea

Oligomenorrhea is infrequent or widely spaced menstrual bleeding, often from anovulation, polycystic ovary syndrome, endocrine disease, undernutrition, excessive exercise, stress, or perimenopause.

## Oligomycin

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oligomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## Oligonucleotide

An oligonucleotide is a short single- or double-stranded DNA or RNA sequence used in molecular biology, diagnostics, antisense therapy, gene silencing, or sequencing.

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### Oligopeptide

oligopeptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in oligopeptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### Oligosaccharide

An oligosaccharide is a short chain of monosaccharides found in glycoproteins, glycolipids, and foods; its structure influences cell recognition, digestion, and the intestinal microbiome.

### Olivary Nucleus

The olivary nucleus is a brainstem structure that sends timing and motor-learning signals to the cerebellum through climbing fibers.

### Olivomycin

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called olivomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Olivopontocerebellar Atrophy

Olivopontocerebellar atrophy is a degenerative condition affecting the inferior olives, pons, and cerebellum, causing progressive ataxia and other neurologic dysfunction.

### Olmesartan Medoxomil

A medical term referring to olmesartan medoxomil. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Olopatadine Hydrochloride

Olopatadine hydrochloride is an antihistamine used in eye drops or nasal spray to treat allergic conjunctivitis or rhinitis.

### Olsenella

olsenella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### Olsenella Uli

A biomedical term referring to olsenella uli; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### Oltipraz

Oltipraz is an investigational dithiole compound studied for activation of cellular antioxidant defenses and cancer prevention.

### Omacetaxine Mepesuccinate

Omacetaxine mepesuccinate is a protein-synthesis inhibitor used for selected chronic myeloid leukemia resistant or intolerant to tyrosine-kinase inhibitors.

### Omalizumab

Omalizumab is a monoclonal antibody that binds circulating IgE and reduces allergic inflammation; it is used for selected allergic asthma, chronic urticaria, nasal polyps, and food allergy, with rare anaphylaxis.

### Omasum

The omasum is the third compartment of a ruminant stomach, absorbing water and small particles before contents reach the abomasum.

### Omega-N-Methylarginine

Omega-N-methylarginine is a methylated arginine compound that can inhibit nitric-oxide synthase and affect vascular signaling.

### Omeprazole

Omeprazole is a proton-pump inhibitor that irreversibly suppresses gastric H<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup>-ATPase; it treats reflux and peptic-ulcer disease and supports *Helicobacter pylori* eradication, while prolonged use may affect magnesium, B12, bone, and infection risk.

### Ommaya Reservoir

A medical term referring to ommaya reservoir. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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## **Oncocytic Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving oncocytic neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## **Oncogenic Virus**

oncogenic virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## **Oncogenicity**

A medical term referring to oncogenicity. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Oncology Nursing**

Oncology nursing provides cancer-related assessment, treatment support, symptom control, education, coordination, survivorship, and end-of-life care.

## **Oncolytic Virotherapy**

oncolytic virotherapy is used in relation to oncolytic virotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## **Oncolytic Viruses**

oncolytic viruses is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## **Oncoprotein**

oncoprotein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

## **Oncostatin M**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oncostatin m. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **Ondansetron**

Ondansetron is a selective 5-HT<sub>3</sub>-receptor antagonist used to prevent nausea and vomiting after chemotherapy, radiotherapy, surgery, or other triggers; constipation, headache, and QT prolongation can occur.

## **Ondansetron Hydrochloride**

A medical term referring to ondansetron hydrochloride. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Onychomadesis**

Onychomadesis is proximal separation and shedding of a nail caused by temporary arrest of nail-matrix growth, often after infection, systemic illness, trauma, or medication exposure.

## **Oogonium**

An oogonium is an early female germ cell that proliferates during embryonic development and gives rise to primary oocytes.

## **Ooplasm**

Ooplasm is the cytoplasm of an egg cell, containing organelles, nutrients, and molecular factors that support fertilization and early embryo development.

## **Open Bite**

An open bite is a malocclusion in which upper and lower teeth do not meet in part of the mouth when the jaws are closed.

## **Operant Conditioning**

A clinical condition or finding involving operant conditioning. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## **Operating Room**

An operating room is a controlled sterile or semi-sterile clinical area equipped for surgical procedures, anesthesia, monitoring, and recovery support.

## **Operating Tables**

A medical term referring to operating tables. Its

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clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Operon**

An operon is a group of adjacent prokaryotic genes controlled by a shared promoter and regulatory elements and transcribed as one messenger-RNA unit.

### **Ophthalmic Solution**

A biological or biochemical term involving ophthalmic solution. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Opiate Alkaloid**

An opiate alkaloid is a naturally occurring alkaloid from the opium poppy, such as morphine or codeine, with opioid analgesic and dependence potential.

### **Opiate Assay**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to opiate assay. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Opiate Overdose**

opiate overdose refers to harmful exposure to the named substance or condition; severity depends on dose, route, timing, symptoms, and patient factors, and urgent professional assessment may be required.

### **Opioid Receptor**

opioid receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Opisthorchis Felineus**

A biomedical term referring to opisthorchis felineus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Oprelvekin**

A medical term referring to oprelvekin. Its clinical

meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Optic Chiasma**

The optic chiasma is the brain structure where fibers from the nasal halves of the optic nerves cross, enabling coordinated visual-field processing.

### **Optic Nerve Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving optic nerve disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Optic Tract**

The optic tract is a neural pathway carrying post-chiasmal visual signals to the lateral geniculate nucleus and other brain regions.

### **Optical Illusion**

optical illusion is a pharmacologic, physiologic, or clinical-care concept used to describe a measurable effect, intervention, or patient-management issue.

### **Optical Rotation**

optical rotation is a pharmacologic, physiologic, or clinical-care concept used to describe a measurable effect, intervention, or patient-management issue.

### **Optical Trap**

optical trap is a pharmacologic, physiologic, or clinical-care concept used to describe a measurable effect, intervention, or patient-management issue.

### **Oral Administration**

A biological or biochemical term involving oral administration. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Oral Health**

Oral health is the condition of the teeth, gums, mouth, jaw, and related functions such as eating, speaking, and swallowing.

### **Oral Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving oral hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and manage-



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ment depend on the clinical context.

### **Oral Spray**

A medical term referring to oral spray. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Orantinib**

A medical term referring to orantinib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Orbital Contusion**

A biological or biochemical term involving orbital contusion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Orbital Fractures**

A clinical condition or finding involving orbital fractures. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Orbital Myositis**

Orbital myositis is inflammation of extraocular muscles causing eye pain, swelling, double vision, and restricted movement.

### **Orbital Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving orbital neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Orbivirus**

orbivirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Order Coleoptera**

A medical term referring to order coleoptera. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Order Spirochaetales**

A medical term referring to order spirochaetales. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oregovomab**

A medical term referring to oregovomab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Orexin**

Orexin, or hypocretin, is a hypothalamic neuropeptide that promotes wakefulness, arousal, appetite, and energy regulation; loss of orexin signaling is strongly associated with narcolepsy type 1.

### **Organ Culture**

organ culture is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Organ Transplantation**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to organ transplantation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Organic Chemical**

organic chemical is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

### **Organic Impurity**

An organic impurity is an unintended carbon-containing chemical in a medicine, material, or specimen that may affect safety, quality, or measurement.

### **Organic Oxide**

An organic oxide is a carbon-containing compound bearing oxygen in an oxidized form; properties and toxicity depend on its molecular structure.

### **Organization Name**

organization name is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

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## Organogenesis

organogenesis is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

## Organoid

An organoid is a three-dimensional cell culture that self-organizes to model selected structure or function of an organ for research or testing.

## Organometallic Compound

An organometallic compound contains a chemical bond between carbon and a metal and may have industrial, laboratory, medicinal, or toxicologic significance.

## Organosilicon Compounds

Organosilicon compounds contain silicon bonded to carbon and are used in materials, medicines, devices, and industry; biological effects depend on the specific compound.

## Ornithine

A medical term referring to ornithine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Ornithine Decarboxylase

A medical term referring to ornithine decarboxylase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Oropharyngeal

Oropharyngeal means relating to the mouth and the part of the throat behind it, including structures involved in breathing, swallowing, and speech.

## Oropharyngeal Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving oropharyngeal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Orotic Aciduria

orotic aciduria is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences mem-

branes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## Orphenadrine

A medical term referring to orphenadrine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Ortataxel

Ortataxel is an investigational taxane-like antineoplastic drug studied for its ability to disrupt microtubules and inhibit cancer-cell division.

## Orthobunyavirus

orthobunyavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Orthodontic Appliance

A medical term referring to orthodontic appliance. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Orthodontic Wires

A medical term referring to orthodontic wires. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Orthohepadnavirus

orthohepadnavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Orthokeratosis

Orthokeratosis is thickening of the outer skin layer with mature keratin cells lacking nuclei, occurring normally or in several skin disorders.

## Orthomyxoviridae

orthomyxoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause

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disease.

### **Orthopoxvirus**

orthopoxvirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Orthoptera**

A medical term referring to orthoptera. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Orthoreovirus**

orthoreovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Orthotic Devices**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving orthotic devices. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Os Odontoideum**

Os odontoideum is a separate ossicle near the second cervical vertebra's odontoid process that can cause atlantoaxial instability or spinal-cord risk.

### **Oscillometry**

A medical term referring to oscillometry. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oseltamivir**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oseltamivir. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Oseltamivir Phosphate**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oseltamivir phosphate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Osmium Tetroxide**

A medical term referring to osmium tetroxide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osmoregulation**

A biological or biochemical term involving osmoregulation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Osseous Metaplasia**

Osseous metaplasia is formation of mature bone in tissue where bone is not normally present, sometimes after injury, inflammation, or within a lesion.

### **Ossifying Fibroma**

An ossifying fibroma is a usually benign fibro-osseous tumor that replaces normal bone with fibrous tissue and mineralized material, often in the jaw.

### **Osteitis Deformans**

Osteitis deformans is Paget disease of bone, in which abnormal remodeling produces enlarged, weakened, or deformed bones.

### **Osteoblastoma**

A medical term referring to osteoblastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osteocalcin**

A medical term referring to osteocalcin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osteocalcin Assay**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to osteocalcin assay. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Osteochondromatosis**

Osteochondromatosis is formation of multiple cartilage-capped bony outgrowths, usually around growth plates, that can cause deformity, pain, or nerve and vessel compression.

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### **Osteolysis**

Osteolysis is progressive destruction or resorption of bone caused by tumors, inflammation, prosthesis reactions, infection, metabolic disease, or other processes.

### **Osteoma Cutis**

Osteoma cutis is formation of bone within the skin or subcutaneous tissue, occurring as a primary disorder or secondary to acne, trauma, or another condition.

### **Osteon**

An osteon, or Haversian system, is the cylindrical structural unit of compact bone surrounding a central blood-vessel and nerve canal.

### **Osteonectin**

A medical term referring to osteonectin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osteopoikilosis**

Osteopoikilosis is an inherited benign bone condition with multiple small dense spots on imaging, usually asymptomatic and discovered incidentally.

### **Osteopontin**

A medical term referring to osteopontin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osteoporotic Fracture**

A clinical condition or finding involving osteoporotic fracture. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Osteoprotegerin Test**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to osteoprotegerin test. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Osteoradionecrosis**

A biological or biochemical term involving osteoradionecrosis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Osteosclerosis**

Osteosclerosis is abnormal increased bone density caused by defective remodeling, inherited disease, chronic stress, inflammation, medicines, or malignancy.

### **Other**

Other indicates a category or finding not fitting the listed alternatives; its medical meaning depends on the surrounding classification or clinical context.

### **Other Race**

Other race is a demographic category for a person who does not select or fit the available listed race categories; classification varies by system and should not be treated as a biological diagnosis.

### **Otic Ointment**

A medical term referring to otic ointment. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Otolaryngologist**

An otolaryngologist is a physician specializing in disorders of the ear, nose, throat, head, neck, voice, swallowing, and related surgery.

### **Ounce**

An ounce is a unit of mass or fluid volume whose exact conversion depends on the measurement system; medication instructions should use unambiguous units.

### **Outcomes Research**

Outcomes research studies how healthcare interventions, services, and policies affect survival, function, quality of life, safety, cost, and patient experience.

### **Ovalbumin**

A medical term referring to ovalbumin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ovalocyte Count**

ovalocyte count is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation

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depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### **Ovarian Failure**

Ovarian failure is inadequate ovarian hormone production or ovulation, causing irregular or absent periods, infertility, and low-estrogen symptoms.

### **Ovarian Fibromata**

Ovarian fibromata are usually benign fibrous tumors of the ovary that may be incidental or cause pelvic pressure, pain, or fluid in the abdomen.

### **Ovarian Follicle**

An ovarian follicle is a fluid-containing structure holding an immature egg and supporting cells; one usually matures and ovulates during each cycle.

### **Ovarian Gonadoblastoma**

A medical term referring to ovarian gonadoblastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ovarian Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving ovarian hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ovarian Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving ovarian infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Ovarian Rupture**

Ovarian rupture is tearing of an ovary or ovarian cyst, which may cause sudden pelvic pain and internal bleeding and sometimes requires urgent treatment.

### **Ovarian Teratoma**

An ovarian teratoma is a germ-cell tumor containing tissues from one or more embryonic layers; mature teratomas are usually benign, while immature forms can be malignant.

### **Ovarian Thecoma**

An ovarian thecoma is a usually benign sex-cord stromal tumor that may produce estrogen and cause abnormal uterine bleeding or other hormonal effects.

### **Ovary Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving ovary disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ovary Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving ovary neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Overbite**

A medical term referring to overbite. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Overlay Denture**

A medical term referring to overlay denture. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oversedate**

A medical term referring to oversedate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oviposition**

A biological or biochemical term involving oviposition. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ovomucin**

A medical term referring to ovomucin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ovotestis**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to ovotestis. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Ownership**

Ownership is legal or practical control of property, data, decisions, or responsibilities; healthcare deci-

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sions remain with the patient or authorized surrogate.

### **Oxacillin**

A medical term referring to oxacillin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxalates**

Oxalates are salts or esters of oxalic acid that can bind calcium and form calcium-oxalate kidney stones; excess dietary absorption or inherited hyperoxaluria can cause renal injury.

### **Oxaliplatin**

Oxaliplatin is a platinum chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used especially in colorectal cancer regimens; acute cold-triggered neuropathy and cumulative sensory neuropathy are characteristic toxicities.

### **Oxandrolone**

A medical term referring to oxandrolone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxaprozin**

A medical term referring to oxaprozin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oxazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Oxcarbazepine**

Oxcarbazepine is an antiseizure medicine that blocks voltage-gated sodium channels and treats focal seizures; dizziness, ataxia, rash, and clinically important hyponatraemia may occur.

### **Oxidants**

A medical term referring to oxidants. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxidation-Reduction**

oxidation-reduction is a biological, genetic, biochem-

ical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Oxidopamine**

A medical term referring to oxidopamine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxidoreductase**

An oxidoreductase is an enzyme that catalyzes transfer of electrons or hydrogen between molecules during oxidation-reduction reactions.

### **Oxime**

A medical term referring to oxime. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oximetry**

oximetry is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### **Oxonic Acid**

A biological or biochemical term involving oxonic acid. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Oxprenolol**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oxprenolol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Oxycodone**

Oxycodone is an opioid analgesic used for moderate-to-severe pain; sedation, constipation, respiratory depression, tolerance, dependence, and overdose risk increase with alcohol or other sedatives.

### **Oxycodone Hydrochloride**

A medical term referring to oxycodone hydrochloride. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### Oxygen Pulse

A medical term referring to oxygen pulse. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Oxygen Transport

A medical term referring to oxygen transport. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Oxygenases

A medical term referring to oxygenases. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Oxygenator

A medical term referring to oxygenator. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Oxyhemoglobin

Oxyhemoglobin is hemoglobin bound to oxygen, formed mainly in the lungs and carrying oxygen through arterial blood to tissues.

### Oxylipins

Oxylipins are oxygenated fatty-acid derivatives that act as local mediators of inflammation, vascular tone, pain, and other physiologic responses.

### Oxymetholone

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called oxymetholone. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Oxymorphone

A medical term referring to oxymorphone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Oxyphil Cell

oxyphil cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### Oxyphilic Adenoma

An oxyphilic adenoma is a usually benign glandular tumor composed of cells rich in mitochondria, such as an oncocytic parathyroid or salivary-gland tumor.

### Ozone

Ozone is a reactive form of oxygen that can irritate and injure the airways and lungs when inhaled, despite useful atmospheric and disinfecting roles.

### OAB

Alternate index label; see *Overactive bladder*.

### Obesity, Childhood

Alternate index label; see *Childhood obesity*.

### Obstetric Cholestasis

Alternate index label; see *Cholestasis of pregnancy*.

### Obstructive Sleep Apnea In Children

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric obstructive sleep apnea*.

### Occult Primary Cancer

Alternate index label; see *Carcinoma of unknown primary*.

### Oculocutaneous Albinism

Alternate index label; see *Albinism*.

### Oculosympathetic Palsy

Alternate index label; see *Horner syndrome*.

### ODD

Alternate index label; see *Oppositional defiant disorder (ODD)*.

### Odontogenic Tumors And Cysts

Alternate index label; see *Jaw tumors and cysts*.

### OHSS

Alternate index label; see *Ovarian hyperstimulation syndrome*.

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## **OLP**

Alternate index label; see *Oral lichen planus*.

## **Optic Nerve Glioma**

Alternate index label; see *Optic glioma*.

## **Optic Pathway Glioma**

Alternate index label; see *Optic glioma*.

## **Osteoarthritis, Cervical**

Alternate index label; see *Cervical spondylosis*.

## **Osteonecrosis**

Osteonecrosis is death of bone tissue from inadequate blood supply, causing pain, collapse, and joint damage, commonly in the hip or knee.

## **Osteophytes**

Alternate index label; see *Bone spurs*.

## **Outer Ear Infection**

Alternate index label; see *Swimmer's ear*.

## **Overactive Thyroid**

Alternate index label; see *Hyperthyroidism (overactive thyroid)*.

## **Oxyphil Cell Carcinoma**

Alternate index label; see *Hurthle cell cancer*.

## **Obesity Hypoventilation Syndrome (OHS)**

Obesity hypoventilation syndrome is awake alveolar hypoventilation in a person with obesity after other causes are excluded, commonly accompanied by obstructive sleep apnea and pulmonary hypertension.

## **Obesity In Children**

A clinical condition involving obesity In Children; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## **Obstructive Sleep Apnea - Adults**

Obstructive sleep apnea is repeated upper-airway

collapse during sleep, causing pauses in breathing, oxygen fluctuation, snoring, fragmented sleep, and daytime impairment.

## **Oculoplastic Procedures**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to oculoplastic procedures; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Oil-Based Paint Poisoning**

Oil-based paint poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to oil-based paint poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Oily Hair**

Oily hair involves toxic or environmental exposure to oily hair; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Oily Skin**

Oily skin involves toxic or environmental exposure to oily skin; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Oleander Poisoning**

Oleander poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to oleander poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Omega-3 Fats - Good For Your Heart**

Omega-3 fats - Good for your heart concerns omega-3 fats - good for your heart, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Omphalocele Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to omphalocele repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Online Health Information - What Can**

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## **You Trust?**

Online health information - what can you trust? addresses care related to online health information - what can you trust?, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Open Gallbladder Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to open gallbladder removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Open Lung Biopsy**

Open lung biopsy examines open lung biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Open Pleural Biopsy**

Open pleural biopsy examines open pleural biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Open Spleen Removal In Adults - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to open spleen removal in adults - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Opiate And Opioid Withdrawal**

Opioid withdrawal is a predictable syndrome after reducing or stopping opioid exposure, producing anxiety, sweating, muscle aches, diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, and autonomic symptoms.

## **Opioid Intoxication**

Opioid intoxication can cause euphoria, drowsiness, slowed breathing, pinpoint pupils, impaired coordination, coma, and death; respiratory depression requires immediate emergency treatment.

## **Oral Human Papillomavirus Infection**

Oral human papillomavirus infection examines oral

human papillomavirus infection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Oral Hypoglycemics Overdose**

Oral hypoglycemics overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to oral hypoglycemics overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Oral Mucositis - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to oral mucositis - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Oral Mucous Cyst**

An oral mucous cyst is a mucus-filled lesion caused by salivary-gland duct injury or blockage, often appearing on the lower lip or floor of the mouth.

## **Orbit CT Scan**

Orbit CT scan examines orbit ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Orgasmic Dysfunction In Women**

Orgasmic dysfunction in women examines orgasmic dysfunction in women; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Oropharynx Lesion Biopsy**

Oropharynx lesion biopsy examines oropharynx lesion biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Orthopedic Services**

Orthopedic services addresses care related to orthopedic services, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

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### **Osmolality Blood Test**

Osmolality blood test examines osmolality blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Osmolality Urine Test**

Osmolality urine test examines osmolality urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Osmotic Diuresis**

A medical term referring to osmotic diuresis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osteitis Fibrosa**

Osteitis fibrosa is fibrous replacement and weakening of bone caused by prolonged excess parathyroid hormone, usually in severe hyperparathyroidism.

### **Osteomyelitis - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to osteomyelitis - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Osteomyelitis In Children**

Childhood osteomyelitis is infection of bone, often caused by bacteria entering through blood or trauma, producing pain, fever, swelling, and impaired movement.

### **Osteopenia - Premature Infants**

Osteopenia of prematurity is reduced bone mineralization in premature infants due to immature mineral stores, limited intake, illness, or prolonged intensive care.

### **Osteotomy Of The Knee**

A medical term referring to osteotomy of the knee. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ostomy - Resources**

Ostomy - resources addresses care related to ostomy - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Outdoor Fitness Routine**

A medical term referring to outdoor fitness routine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ovarian Overproduction Of Androgens**

Ovarian overproduction of androgens examines ovarian overproduction of androgens; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Oven Cleaner Poisoning**

Oven cleaner poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to oven cleaner poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Over-The-Counter Medicines**

Over-the-counter medicines examines over-the-counter medicines; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Over-The-Counter Pain Relievers**

Over-the-counter pain relievers examines over-the-counter pain relievers; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Overcoming Breastfeeding Problems**

Breastfeeding problems such as pain, poor latch, low supply, engorgement, or blocked ducts can often improve with feeding assessment, positioning help, and timely lactation or medical support.

### **Overcoming Job Stress**

Overcoming job stress examines overcoming job stress; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clin-

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ical question.

### **Ovulation Home Test**

Ovulation home test examines ovulation home test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Oxalic Acid Poisoning**

Oxalic acid poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to oxalic acid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Oxazepam Overdose**

Oxazepam overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to oxazepam overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Oxygen Safety**

A medical term referring to oxygen safety. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxygen Therapy In Infants**

Oxygen therapy in infants supplements inspired oxygen when gas exchange is inadequate, while careful monitoring limits complications from both hypoxemia and excessive oxygen exposure.

### **Ozena**

Ozena is a chronic form of atrophic rhinitis with widened nasal passages, crusting, foul odor, and impaired mucosal function.

### **OAB (Overactive Bladder)**

Alternate index label for Overactive Bladder.

### **Obesity (Weight Loss)**

Alternate index label for Weight Loss.

### **Objects Or Insects In Ear**

An object or insect in the ear canal can cause pain, hearing loss, bleeding, discharge, or a sensation of

movement. Do not insert tools or liquids; removal by a clinician is safest when the object is deep, sharp, chemical, or near the eardrum.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ear Object In (Objects Or Insects In Ear)

### **Obsessive Compulsive Disorder (OCD)**

Alternate index label for OCD.

### **Onychocryptosis (Ingrown Toenail)**

Alternate index label for Ingrown Toenail.

### **Onychomycosis (Fungal Nails)**

Alternate index label for Fungal Nails.

### **Oral Candidiasis Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children)**

Alternate index label for Thrush and Other Yeast Infections in Children.

### **Oral Health Problems In Children**

Children can develop tooth decay, gum inflammation, mouth trauma, ulcers, malocclusion, infections, and developmental dental problems. Fluoride, brushing with supervision, dental visits, injury prevention, and prompt care for pain, swelling, fever, or trauma protect oral health.

### **Oral Moniliasis Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children)**

Alternate index label for Thrush and Other Yeast Infections in Children.

### **Orgasm Male (Sexual (Sex) Problems In Men)**

Alternate index label for Sexual (Sex) Problems in Men.

### **Osteitis Deformans (Paget's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Paget's Disease.

### **Osteogenesis Imperfecta Brittle Bone Disease**

Osteogenesis imperfecta is an inherited collagen disorder causing fragile bones, recurrent fractures,

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short stature, dentin abnormalities, hearing loss, and variable skeletal deformity. Care may include fracture prevention, rehabilitation, medicines, surgery, and monitoring of hearing and breathing.

**Synonyms:**

Brittle Bone Disease (Osteogenesis Imperfecta Brittle Bone Disease)

**Osteomalacia (Rickets)**

Alternate index label for Rickets.

**Otitis (Ear Infection)**

Alternate index label for Ear Infection.

**Overactive Thyroid (Hyperthyroidism)**

Alternate index label for Hyperthyroidism.

**Overload Iron (Iron Overload)**

Alternate index label for Iron Overload.

**Overuse Syndrome (Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs))**

Alternate index label for Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs).

**Oath Of Maimonides**

The Oath of Maimonides is a historical ethical prayer emphasizing compassion, dedication, humility, and responsibility in the practice of medicine.

**OB**

OB is an abbreviation commonly meaning obstetrics, the care of pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postpartum period, but it may have other meanings.

**OB/GYN**

OB/GYN refers to obstetrics and gynecology, the medical specialties concerned with pregnancy and reproductive-system health.

**Obese**

Obese describes a body-mass index of 30 or higher in adults, though BMI is an imperfect measure and health assessment should include overall risk and function.

**Obesity, Exogenous**

A clinical condition involving obesity, Exogenous; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

**OBS**

OBS is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean observation, obstetric service, or organic brain syndrome; the intended term should be written out.

**Observer Variation**

A biological or biochemical term involving observer variation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

**Obtunded**

A medical term referring to obtunded. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

**Occam's Razor**

Occam's razor is the reasoning principle favoring the simplest explanation that accounts for the findings, while recognizing that patients can have multiple conditions.

**Occipital Hematoma**

A clinical condition involving occipital Hematoma; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

**Occlude**

To occlude means to block or close a passage, vessel, airway, duct, or opening.

**Occupational Therapist**

A biological or biochemical term involving occupational therapist. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

**OCG**

OCG is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to oral contraceptive guidance, oculo-cardiac testing, or another clinical term; the full term should be specified.



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## OCP

OCP commonly means oral contraceptive pill, a medicine containing estrogen, progestin, or both to prevent pregnancy and sometimes treat menstrual disorders.

## OD (Lens Prescription)

OD in an eyeglass prescription means the right eye, from the Latin *oculus dexter*.

## Oligo- (Prefix)

Oligo- is a prefix meaning few, scanty, or small in number or amount.

## Oma

-oma is a suffix commonly indicating a tumor or mass, although some words ending in -oma describe non-neoplastic conditions.

## OMS

OMS is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean oral and maxillofacial surgery or another organization or medical term.

## OMS (World Health Organization)

WHO is the World Health Organization, the United Nations agency coordinating international public-health work; OMS is its acronym in some languages.

## On Call

On call means available and responsible to respond to clinical or operational needs during a designated period outside routine scheduled activity.

## Oneirophrenia

A medical term referring to oneirophrenia. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Onset

Onset is the time or manner in which a symptom, disease, or physiologic change begins, such as sudden, gradual, acute, or insidious onset.

## Onycho- (Prefix)

Onycho- is a prefix meaning relating to a nail or claw.

## Onychocryptosis

Onychocryptosis is an ingrown nail, usually at the great toe, in which the nail edge penetrates surrounding skin and causes pain or inflammation.

## Ophthalmitis

Ophthalmitis is inflammation of the eye and can result from infection, immune disease, trauma, or surgery.

## OR (Abbreviation)

OR commonly means operating room or odds ratio; the intended meaning depends on clinical or statistical context.

## Oral Cholecystogram

Oral cholecystogram is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

## Oral Moniliasis

Oral moniliasis is oral candidiasis, a *Candida* yeast infection causing white plaques, soreness, burning, or altered taste.

## Oral Rehydration Salts

A biological or biochemical term involving oral rehydration salts. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Organ Failure

Organ failure refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

## Organic Brain Syndrome

A clinical condition involving organic Brain Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

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### **Oriental Medicine (Traditional)**

A biological or biochemical term involving oriental medicine (traditional). Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ornithine Transcarbamylase (OTC) Deficiency**

OTC deficiency is an inherited urea-cycle disorder causing ammonia accumulation, vomiting, confusion, seizures, or coma, especially during metabolic stress.

### **Orphan Disease**

A clinical condition involving orphan Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Ortho- (Prefix)**

Ortho- is a prefix meaning straight, correct, upright, or related to orthopedic care depending on the term.

### **Orthodontic Treatment (Dental Braces)**

Orthodontic treatment (dental braces) is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Orthopod**

Orthopod is an informal term for an orthopedic physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of bones, joints, muscles, and related tissues.

### **Orthoscopic**

Orthoscopic means providing a straight or undistorted view, as in an optical instrument or examination.

### **Orthotic**

Orthotic means relating to a brace, splint, insert, or device that supports, aligns, protects, or improves function of a body part.

### **OS (Lens Prescription)**

OS in an eyeglass prescription means the left eye, from the Latin oculus sinister.

### **Oscitation**

A biological or biochemical term involving oscitation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **OSHA**

OSHA is the U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration, which sets and enforces workplace safety and health standards.

### **Osmolar**

A medical term referring to osmolar. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osmole**

A medical term referring to osmole. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Osseous**

Osseous means relating to or composed of bone.

### **Osteo- (Prefix)**

Osteo- is a prefix meaning relating to bone.

### **Osteoarthropathy**

Osteoarthropathy is disease affecting bones and joints, often describing degenerative, hypertrophic, metabolic, or systemic-associated changes.

### **Osteoclasia**

Osteoclasia is surgical or mechanical breaking of bone, historically used to correct deformity.

### **Osteoclasia**

Osteoclasia is deliberate fracture or manipulation of bone, usually to correct deformity or restore alignment.

### **Osteolytic**

Osteolytic means causing or characterized by breakdown and loss of bone tissue.

### **Osteosynthesis**

A medical term referring to osteosynthesis. Its clin-

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ical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ot-**

The term Ot- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **OTC (Over-The-Counter)**

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### **Othello Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving othello Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Oto-**

The term Oto- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Over-The-Counter (OTC) Drug**

A pharmacologic agent associated with over-The-Counter (OTC) Drug; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Oxter**

Oxter is an anatomical term for the armpit or axilla.

### **Oxy**

Oxy- is a prefix relating to oxygen, sharpness, or acidity depending on the medical or chemical term.

### **OxyContin**

OxyContin is an extended-release oxycodone opioid formulation used for selected severe persistent pain and carrying risks of misuse, dependence, and respiratory depression.

### **Oxygen Tent**

A medical term referring to oxygen tent. Its clinical

meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Oxygenation**

A biological or biochemical term involving oxygenation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Oz.**

Oz. is an abbreviation for ounce, a unit of mass or fluid volume whose exact conversion depends on the measurement system.

### **Ovaries**

The paired female gonads that produce oocytes and secrete sex hormones, mainly estrogen and progesterone. They are located on either side of the uterus and participate in the menstrual cycle and reproduction.

#### **Synonyms:**

ovary

### **Oral Thrush**

A fungal infection of the mouth, usually caused by Candida, producing creamy white patches, soreness, or altered taste.

#### **Synonyms:**

Candidiasis, Oral Thrush, Oral

### **Obstructed Labour**

Failure of the fetus to pass through the birth canal despite adequate uterine contractions, commonly because of disproportion, abnormal presentation, or an obstructing lesion.

### **Oral Appliance Therapy**

Treatment using a removable dental appliance during sleep, commonly to advance the mandible or retain the tongue and reduce upper-airway collapse in selected obstructive sleep apnea.

### **Oxygen Desaturation Index**

The average number of oxygen desaturation events per hour of sleep, usually reported from a sleep study as the ODI; interpretation depends on the recording method and clinical context.

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### **Opioid Toxidrome**

A poisoning pattern caused by opioid excess, characterized by respiratory depression, reduced consciousness, and small pupils; naloxone and ventilatory support may be required.

### **Otoplasty**

Surgery to alter the shape, position, or proportion of the external ear, commonly to correct prominent or congenital ear differences.

### **Endometrioid Ovarian Carcinoma**

A malignant ovarian epithelial tumor resembling endometrial glands, sometimes associated with endometriosis and often showing alterations in the PI3K or mismatch-repair pathways.

### **High-Grade Serous Ovarian Carcinoma**

A high-grade tubo-ovarian epithelial carcinoma characterized by marked nuclear atypia and nearly universal abnormality of the TP53 pathway; many arise from the fimbrial fallopian tube.

### **Immature Ovarian Teratoma**

A malignant germ-cell tumor containing immature embryonal tissues, usually diagnosed in adolescents or young adults and graded by the amount of immature neuroepithelium.

### **Mucinous Borderline Ovarian Tumor**

An ovarian mucinous epithelial tumor with cellular proliferation and atypia but without destructive stromal invasion; it may be large and unilateral.

### **Mucinous Ovarian Carcinoma**

A malignant ovarian epithelial tumor composed of invasive mucin-producing cells; metastatic gastrointestinal or pancreatobiliary carcinoma must be excluded.

### **Ovarian Metastasis**

Secondary involvement of the ovary by a malignant tumor arising elsewhere, commonly from the gastrointestinal tract, breast, or gynecologic tract; the distinction from a primary ovarian tumor guides

treatment.

### **Serous Borderline Ovarian Tumor**

An ovarian serous epithelial tumor with hierarchical papillae and cellular atypia but no destructive stromal invasion; extraovarian implants may occur.

### **Small Cell Carcinoma Of The Ovary, Hypercalcemic Type**

A rare, highly aggressive ovarian tumor in young patients, often associated with alterations in SMARCA4 and sometimes presenting with hypercalcemia.

### **Struma Ovarii**

A specialized mature ovarian teratoma composed predominantly of thyroid tissue; it may be hormonally active or develop malignant thyroid-type transformation.

### **Thecoma**

A usually benign ovarian sex-cord stromal tumor composed of theca-like cells, often producing estrogen and presenting with abnormal uterine bleeding or an incidental adnexal mass.

### **Yolk Sac Tumor**

A malignant ovarian germ-cell tumor that often occurs in children or young adults and produces alpha-fetoprotein; it requires prompt treatment.

### **Osteosarcoma, Secondary**

An osteogenic sarcoma arising in previously abnormal or treated bone, such as bone affected by Paget disease, prior radiation, or chronic bone lesions; prognosis and treatment depend on stage and resectability.

## P

### **P Wave**

The first deflection on the ECG, representing atrial depolarization. Normal P waves are upright in leads I and II, inverted in aVR, and less than 0.12 seconds (3 small boxes) in duration and 2.5 mm in amplitude.

### **Pacemaker, Artificial**

An implanted device that sends electrical impulses to maintain an appropriate heart rhythm.

### **Paediatrician**

A physician specializing in the medical care of infants, children, and adolescents.

### **Paediatrics**

The medical specialty concerned with health and disease in infants, children, and adolescents.

### **Pain Clinic**

A service providing assessment and multidisciplinary treatment for acute, chronic, or complex pain.

### **Palate**

The roof of the mouth, consisting of a bony hard palate and muscular soft palate.

### **Palatine**

Relating to the palate or palatine bone.

### **Paliperidone**

An atypical antipsychotic medicine used to treat schizophrenia and schizoaffective disorder.

### **Pallesthesia**

The ability to perceive vibration, tested with a tun-

ing fork and mediated by large sensory fibers.

### **Palliative Surgery**

Surgery intended to relieve symptoms or improve function without necessarily curing the underlying disease.

### **Pallidotomy**

A neurosurgical procedure creating a lesion in the globus pallidus to reduce selected symptoms of advanced Parkinson disease.

### **Pallor**

Unusual paleness of skin or mucous membranes, often due to reduced blood flow, anemia, or other illness.

### **Palm**

The inner surface of the hand between the wrist and fingers.

### **Palmar**

Relating to the palm of the hand.

### **Palpebra**

An eyelid.

### **Palsy**

Weakness or paralysis, often involving a specific nerve or muscle group.

### **Panacea**

A supposed remedy for all diseases; it is not a recognized medical treatment.

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## **Pancreas, Diseases Of**

Disorders affecting the pancreas, including pancreatitis, cysts, tumors, diabetes, and exocrine insufficiency.

## **Pancreazymine**

An older name for cholecystokinin, a hormone that stimulates pancreatic enzyme secretion and gallbladder contraction.

## **Panendoscopy**

Endoscopic examination of several connected parts of the upper aerodigestive tract, often the pharynx, larynx, and oesophagus.

## **Panmyelopathy**

Disease affecting multiple cell lines or functions of the bone marrow and spinal cord; the term is uncommon and context-dependent.

## **Panophthalmitis**

Severe inflammation involving all coats and internal contents of the eye, usually due to infection and threatening vision.

## **Pantothenic Acid**

Vitamin B5, a component of coenzyme A required for fatty-acid and energy metabolism.

## **Papain**

A proteolytic enzyme from papaya latex used in some food and historical medicinal preparations.

## **Papanicolaou (Pap) Test**

A screening test in which cervical cells are examined for precancerous changes and cancer.

## **Papillectomy**

Surgical removal of a papilla or papillary lesion, such as an ampullary tumor.

## **Papilloedema**

Swelling of the optic discs caused by raised intracranial pressure.

## **Papillomavirus**

A papillomavirus, especially human papillomavirus, which can cause warts and some anogenital, oropharyngeal, and other cancers.

## **Papule**

A small, solid, raised skin lesion, usually less than 1 centimeter in diameter.

## **Para-**

A combining form meaning beside, beyond, abnormal, or closely related, depending on the word.

## **Paracusia**

A disorder of hearing in which sounds are perceived abnormally or inaccurately.

## **Paraesthesia**

An abnormal sensation such as tingling, pins and needles, burning, or numbness.

## **Paraffin**

A mixture of hydrocarbons used in laboratory tissue processing, topical preparations, and other applications; some forms are flammable.

## **Parageusia**

An altered or unpleasant sense of taste.

## **Paragraphia**

A language disorder involving incorrect or unintended words or written symbols.

## **Paraldehyde**

An older sedative and anticonvulsant medicine with limited current use.

## **Paralysis**

Loss of voluntary muscle movement in part or all of the body due to nervous-system or muscle disease.

## **Paralysis Agitans**

An older name for Parkinson disease, characterized by tremor, rigidity, and bradykinesia.



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### **Paralytic Ileus**

Failure of intestinal peristalsis without a mechanical blockage, causing abdominal distension, pain, vomiting, and absent or reduced bowel sounds.

### **Paramedical**

Relating to healthcare professionals or services that support medical practice, such as physiotherapy, radiography, or emergency medical care.

### **Parametritis**

Inflammation of the connective tissue beside the uterus, often following pelvic infection or childbirth.

### **Paramnesia**

A memory disturbance involving false, distorted, or inaccurately familiar recollections.

### **Paranoid**

Marked by persistent or excessive suspiciousness and distrust.

### **Paranoid Psychosis**

An older term for psychosis dominated by delusions of persecution, reference, or grandeur.

### **Paranoid Schizophrenia**

An obsolete subtype label for schizophrenia with prominent delusions and hallucinations; current classification uses symptom dimensions.

### **Paraparesis**

Weakness affecting both legs, usually due to spinal-cord, brain, nerve, or muscle disease.

### **Paraphasia**

Substitution, omission, or distortion of sounds or words during speech, usually due to aphasia.

### **Paraplegia**

Paralysis of both legs and often part of the trunk, usually from spinal-cord or neurologic disease.

### **Paratyphoid Fever**

An enteric fever caused by *Salmonella Paratyphi*, transmitted mainly through contaminated food or water.

### **Parenchyma**

The functional tissue of an organ, distinguished from its supporting connective tissue or stroma.

### **Paresis**

Partial weakness or incomplete paralysis.

### **Paresthesia**

An abnormal sensation such as tingling, prickling, burning, or pins and needles.

### **Parietal**

Relating to a wall of a body cavity or to the parietal bone or lobe of the skull and brain.

### **Parietal Bone**

One of two bones forming much of the sides and roof of the skull.

### **Parotitis**

Inflammation of the parotid salivary gland.

### **Paroxysm**

A sudden attack or burst of symptoms or physiologic activity.

### **Paroxysmal Nocturnal Haemoglobinuria**

An acquired clonal stem-cell disorder causing complement-mediated hemolysis, thrombosis, and variable bone-marrow failure.

### **Pars**

A part or portion of an anatomical structure, used in names such as *pars interarticularis*.

### **Passive Immunity**

Protection produced by transferred antibodies rather than by the person's own immune response, such as maternal antibodies or immunoglobulin

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treatment.

### **Pasteurella**

A genus of bacteria carried by animals that can cause wound infections after bites and other human disease.

### **Pathognomonic**

So characteristic of a disease that it strongly identifies that disease when present.

### **Patient-Controlled Analgesia (PCA)**

A system allowing a patient to self-administer preset doses of analgesic through a programmed pump with safety limits.

### **Peak Flow Meter**

A handheld device measuring peak expiratory flow, useful for monitoring variable airflow obstruction such as asthma.

### **Pectoral**

Relating to the chest or breast.

### **Pectoralis**

A muscle of the chest, chiefly pectoralis major or pectoralis minor.

### **Pediculosis**

Infestation by lice.

### **Pedigree**

A diagram showing family relationships and inheritance of traits or disease.

### **Pedodontics**

The branch of dentistry concerned with infants, children, and adolescents.

### **Pellagra**

A disease caused by niacin deficiency, classically producing dermatitis, diarrhea, and neuropsychiatric changes.

### **Pelvimeter**

An instrument used to measure pelvic dimensions.

### **Pelvis**

The bony ring and associated soft tissues at the base of the trunk, connecting the spine with the lower limbs.

### **Pemphigoid**

A group of autoimmune subepidermal blistering disorders, including bullous pemphigoid.

### **Pemphigus**

A group of autoimmune intraepidermal blistering disorders caused by antibodies against desmosomal proteins.

### **Pendular**

Moving or swinging freely like a pendulum; pendular nystagmus has a similar speed in both directions.

### **Penetrating Wounds**

Wounds caused by an object entering tissue and potentially damaging deeper structures.

### **Penicillamine**

A chelating and immunomodulatory medicine used in selected copper overload and autoimmune disorders.

### **Penicillin**

A beta-lactam antibiotic group that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis.

### **Penis**

The male external genital organ used for urination and sexual reproduction.

### **Pentaerythritol Tetranitrate**

An organic nitrate with vasodilator activity, mainly of historical or specialized pharmaceutical interest.

### **Pentamidine**

An antiprotozoal and antimicrobial medicine used

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for selected leishmaniasis, trypanosomiasis, and Pneumocystis infections.

### **Pentazocine**

An opioid analgesic with mixed agonist-antagonist activity.

### **Pentobarbital**

A barbiturate sedative and anticonvulsant with substantial respiratory-depression and overdose risk.

### **Peppermint**

Mentha piperita, used as a flavoring and in some preparations for dyspeptic symptoms; concentrated oil can be hazardous.

### **Pepsinogen**

An inactive precursor released by gastric chief cells and converted to pepsin in acidic conditions.

### **Peptic Ulcer**

A break in the lining of the stomach or duodenum caused commonly by Helicobacter pylori or NSAIDs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stomach Ulcer (Peptic Ulcer) Ulcer, Peptic

### **Peptidase**

An enzyme that breaks peptide bonds in proteins or peptides.

### **Peptide**

A short chain of amino acids linked by peptide bonds.

### **Perceptual**

Relating to the process of detecting and interpreting sensory information.

### **Percussion**

Tapping the body surface to assess the underlying tissue by its sound and transmitted vibration.

### **Percutaneous**

Performed through the skin, usually with a needle,

catheter, or other instrument.

### **Perforation**

A hole or rupture through the wall of an organ or tissue.

### **Perfusion**

Passage of blood or another fluid through a tissue or organ.

### **Pericardial Effusion**

Excess fluid in the pericardial sac surrounding the heart; rapid accumulation can cause tamponade.

### **Pericarditis**

Inflammation of the pericardium, with or without fluid accumulation. Acute pericarditis commonly causes sharp chest pain that worsens with breathing and improves when sitting up or leaning forward. Diagnosis is based on clinical findings, such as a pericardial friction rub, characteristic electrocardiographic changes, or a new pericardial effusion. Causes include infection, autoimmune disease, myocardial injury, kidney failure, cancer, trauma, and some medicines. Complications include cardiac tamponade, recurrence, and constrictive pericarditis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Inflamed Pericardium Pericardial Inflammation Pericardial Disease (Pericarditis)

### **Pericardium**

The double-layered sac surrounding the heart and the roots of the great vessels.

### **Perichondrium**

The connective-tissue covering surrounding most cartilage.

### **Perineum**

The region between the external genitalia and anus.

### **Periodontal Disease**

Inflammatory or infectious disease of the tissues supporting the teeth, including gingivitis and periodontitis.

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### **Periodontics**

The dental specialty concerned with the gums and supporting tissues of the teeth.

### **Periodontitis**

A chronic inflammatory disease caused by dysbiotic dental plaque that destroys the periodontal ligament and alveolar bone supporting the teeth. It can cause bleeding gums, periodontal pockets, tooth mobility, recession, bad breath, and tooth loss; severity and progression vary and require dental evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Periodontal Disease, Periodontitis

### **Periodontium**

The tissues supporting a tooth: gingiva, periodontal ligament, cementum, and alveolar bone.

### **Periosteum**

A vascular connective-tissue membrane covering the outer surface of bone except at articular cartilage.

### **Periostitis**

Inflammation of the periosteum.

### **Periurethral**

Situated around the urethra.

### **Perleche**

Angular cheilitis, inflammation and cracking at the corners of the mouth.

### **Permanent Teeth**

The adult set of teeth that replaces the deciduous teeth.

### **Permethrin**

A topical pyrethroid medicine used mainly to treat scabies and head lice.

### **Pernicious Anaemia**

An autoimmune cause of vitamin B12 deficiency due to impaired intrinsic-factor-mediated absorption.

### **Peroneal**

Relating to the fibula or the muscles and nerve on the outer side of the lower leg.

### **Perphenazine**

A phenothiazine antipsychotic and antiemetic medicine.

### **Perspiration**

Sweat produced by eccrine and apocrine glands.

### **Pertussis**

Whooping cough, a contagious respiratory infection caused by *Bordetella pertussis*.

### **Pervasive Developmental Disorders**

An obsolete group term for disorders involving social communication and restricted repetitive behavior, including autism-spectrum conditions.

### **Pessary**

A device placed in the vagina to support pelvic organs or deliver medication.

### **Pesticide**

A substance used to control insects, weeds, fungi, or other pests; exposure can cause poisoning.

### **PET Scan**

An imaging study using a positron-emitting tracer to measure metabolism, receptor activity, or tissue function.

### **Petechiae**

Tiny nonblanching red or purple spots caused by small areas of bleeding into the skin or mucosa.

### **Petit Mal**

An older term for absence seizures, brief episodes of impaired awareness with characteristic generalized EEG activity.

### **Petrissage**

A massage technique involving kneading or lifting

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soft tissues.

### **Petrolatum**

A semisolid mixture of hydrocarbons used as a protective skin ointment and moisture barrier.

### **Petrous**

Dense and rock-like; usually referring to the petrous part of the temporal bone.

### **Phagocyte**

A cell that engulfs and digests microorganisms, dead cells, or foreign particles.

### **Phagocytosis**

The process by which a cell surrounds, ingests, and digests a particle or microorganism.

### **Phalanges**

The bones of the fingers and toes.

### **Phalanx**

One of the bones of a finger or toe.

### **Phallic Stage**

A historical psychoanalytic developmental stage centered on genital awareness; it is not a modern disease classification.

### **Pharmaceutical**

Relating to medicines or the preparation and manufacture of medicines.

### **Pharmacist**

A healthcare professional trained in medicines, including their preparation, dispensing, safety, and use.

### **Pharmacodynamics**

The study of what a drug does to the body, including its molecular targets, mechanism of action, dose-response relationship, therapeutic effects, and adverse effects.

### **Pharmacokinetics**

The study of what the body does to a drug, including absorption, distribution, metabolism, and excretion (ADME), and how drug concentrations change over time.

### **Pharmacology**

The study of drugs, their actions, uses, adverse effects, and interactions.

### **Pharmacy**

The science and practice of preparing, supplying, and advising on medicines.

### **Pharyngeal**

Relating to the pharynx.

### **Pharyngitis**

Inflammation of the pharynx, commonly causing sore throat and pain on swallowing.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sore Throat (Pharyngitis)

### **Pharynx**

The muscular throat passage behind the nose and mouth that leads to the larynx and oesophagus.

### **Phenelzine**

A monoamine oxidase inhibitor antidepressant requiring attention to interactions and dietary precautions.

### **Phenindione**

An older oral anticoagulant that interferes with vitamin-K-dependent clotting factors.

### **Phenobarbitone**

The British name for phenobarbital, a barbiturate anticonvulsant and sedative.

### **Phenol**

A corrosive aromatic compound used in chemical and laboratory applications and in some medical preparations.

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**Phenomenon**

An observable event, sign, or process.

**Phenothiazines**

A class of medicines including antipsychotic and antiemetic drugs.

**Phenoxybenzamine**

An irreversible alpha-adrenergic blocker used mainly before surgery for pheochromocytoma.

**Phenoxymethylpenicillin**

Penicillin V, an oral penicillin used for selected susceptible infections.

**Pentermine**

A sympathomimetic appetite suppressant used short term in selected weight-management plans.

**Phenylbutazone**

An older NSAID with serious blood, kidney, gastrointestinal, and other toxicity risks.

**Phenylephrine**

An alpha-adrenergic agonist used as a decongestant, vasopressor, or pupil dilator.

**Phenylketonuria (PKU)**

An inherited deficiency of phenylalanine hydroxylase causing phenylalanine accumulation and neurologic injury without early treatment.

**Synonyms:**

PKU

**Phenytoin**

An anticonvulsant that blocks voltage-gated sodium channels and treats selected seizures.

**Pheochromocytoma**

A catecholamine-producing tumor of chromaffin cells, usually in the adrenal medulla, causing episodic or sustained hypertension.

**Synonyms:**

Tumor Adrenal Gland (Pheochromocytoma)

**Phimosis**

Inability to retract the foreskin behind the glans; pathologic cases may cause pain, infection, or urinary difficulty.

**Phlebitis**

Inflammation of a vein, sometimes associated with thrombosis.

**Phlegm**

Thick mucus coughed up from the lower respiratory tract.

**Phobia**

An excessive, persistent fear of a specific object or situation that leads to avoidance or distress.

**Phobic Disorder**

A disorder characterized by clinically significant fear and avoidance of a particular object or situation.

**Phocomelia**

A rare congenital limb-development defect in which hands or feet are attached close to the trunk because of absent or severely shortened long bones.

**Phonocardiogram**

A graphic recording of heart sounds and murmurs.

**Phosphate**

A salt or ester of phosphoric acid; phosphate is important in bone, energy metabolism, and cellular signaling.

**Phospholipid**

A lipid containing phosphate that forms a major component of cell membranes.

**Phosphorus**

An essential element in bone, nucleic acids, phospholipids, and ATP.

**Phosphorylation**

Addition of a phosphate group to a molecule, often



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regulating protein activity or energy transfer.

### **Photophobia**

Abnormal sensitivity or intolerance to light.

### **Phototherapy**

Treatment using controlled light, such as for neonatal jaundice, psoriasis, or seasonal affective disorder.

### **Phrenic**

Relating to the diaphragm or the phrenic nerve.

### **Phrenic Nerve**

The nerve arising mainly from C3-C5 that supplies the diaphragm and carries sensory fibers from nearby structures.

### **Phthiriasis**

Infestation by lice, especially the pubic louse.

### **Phthisis**

An obsolete term for wasting or shrinkage of an organ, especially a severely damaged eye or lung.

### **Physical Medicine**

The medical specialty focused on function, rehabilitation, pain, and restoration of independence after illness or injury.

### **Physician**

A licensed medical doctor who diagnoses, treats, and prevents disease.

### **Physiotherapy**

Assessment and treatment using movement, exercise, manual techniques, education, and physical modalities to improve function.

### **Physiology**

The study of normal functions and processes of living organisms and their parts.

### **Pia Mater**

The delicate innermost membrane closely covering

the brain and spinal cord.

### **Pica**

Persistent eating of nonnutritive substances inappropriate for developmental level or culture.

### **Pick's Disease**

An older term for frontotemporal dementia associated with characteristic Pick bodies; current classification uses specific frontotemporal dementia syndromes.

### **Pickwickian Syndrome**

An older name for obesity hypoventilation syndrome, involving obesity, daytime hypercapnia, and sleep-disordered breathing.

### **Pilocarpine**

A muscarinic agonist used to constrict the pupil, lower intraocular pressure, or stimulate salivation.

### **Pimozide**

An antipsychotic medicine used in selected disorders, with important cardiac and neurologic adverse effects.

### **Pimple**

A common lay term for a small inflamed or blocked skin lesion, often an acne papule or pustule.

### **Pineal Gland**

An endocrine gland in the brain that secretes melatonin and helps regulate circadian timing.

### **Pink Eye**

A lay term for conjunctivitis, inflammation of the conjunctiva causing redness and discharge.

#### **Synonyms:**

Conjunctivitis (Pink Eye)

### **Pinna**

The visible external part of the ear that collects sound.

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### **Pinocytosis**

Cellular uptake of extracellular fluid and dissolved substances in small vesicles.

### **Pint**

A unit of volume; its exact value varies by measurement system and country.

### **Pinta**

A chronic skin infection caused by *Treponema carateum*, producing changing stages of pigmentary lesions.

### **Pinworm**

The intestinal nematode *Enterobius vermicularis*, which commonly causes nocturnal perianal itching.

### **Piperazine**

An older anthelmintic used against selected intestinal worms.

### **Pipotiazine**

A long-acting phenothiazine antipsychotic administered in selected settings.

### **Pipradrol**

An older central nervous system stimulant with limited current use.

### **Piracetam**

A nootropic compound used in some countries for selected neurologic indications; evidence and approval vary.

### **Piroplasmosis**

An animal disease caused by *Babesia* or *Theileria* parasites; human babesiosis is a related infection.

### **Pits**

Small depressions or holes; in dermatology, pits may occur in nails or skin lesions.

### **Pituitary Gland**

An endocrine gland at the base of the brain that

regulates growth, thyroid, adrenal, reproductive, lactation, and water-balance hormones.

### **Pityriasis**

A group of skin disorders characterized by fine scaling, including pityriasis rosea and versicolor.

### **Placebo**

An inactive or nonspecific treatment used as a comparison or whose effects arise from expectation and care context.

### **Placenta**

The temporary organ connecting mother and fetus, allowing exchange of oxygen, nutrients, wastes, and hormones.

### **Placenta Praevia**

Placental implantation over or near the cervical opening, causing risk of painless late-pregnancy bleeding.

### **Plague**

A serious infection caused by *Yersinia pestis*, transmitted mainly by infected fleas or respiratory droplets in pneumonic disease.

### **Planar**

Flat or lying in a single plane; planar imaging produces a two-dimensional projection.

### **Plantar**

Relating to the sole of the foot.

### **Plantar Reflex**

The response produced by stroking the sole of the foot; an extensor response in an adult suggests corticospinal-tract dysfunction.

### **Plantar Wart**

A wart caused by human papillomavirus on the sole of the foot, often painful with pressure.

### **Plaque**

A flat, raised, or deposited area of material or tissue;

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examples include dental plaque, arterial plaque, and skin plaques.

### **Plasma Expanders**

Intravenous fluids intended to increase circulating volume, including crystalloids and selected colloids.

### **Plasmacytoma**

A localized tumor of abnormal plasma cells, occurring in bone or soft tissue and sometimes progressing to multiple myeloma.

### **Plasmapheresis**

Removal of plasma from blood, with return of cellular components and replacement fluid, to remove pathogenic antibodies or substances.

### **Plasmodium**

A genus of parasites transmitted by Anopheles mosquitoes and responsible for malaria.

### **Plaster Of Paris**

Calcium sulfate hemihydrate that sets into a hard material, used for casts, splints, and models.

### **Plastic Surgery**

Surgery that reconstructs, restores, or alters body tissues for functional or cosmetic reasons.

### **Platelet**

A small blood cell fragment that helps form the initial plug in hemostasis.

### **Platelet Count**

The number of platelets in a given volume of blood, used to assess bleeding or clotting risk.

### **Platybasia**

Flattening of the skull base, measured by an increased basal angle and sometimes associated with neurologic compression.

### **Platysma**

A thin superficial muscle of the neck that tenses the skin and assists lower-jaw and lower-lip movement.

### **Pleat**

A fold of tissue or material; in anatomy it may describe a fold of mucosa or serosa.

### **Pleura**

The double-layered membrane surrounding each lung and lining the inner chest wall.

### **Pleural Effusion**

Excess fluid in the pleural space between the lung and chest wall.

### **Pleurisy**

Inflammation of the pleura, often causing sharp pain worsened by breathing.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pleuritis (Pleurisy)

### **Pleurodynia**

Severe, often episodic chest or upper-abdominal muscle pain associated with viral infection, especially coxsackievirus.

### **Plexus**

A network of intersecting nerves, vessels, or other structures.

### **Plica**

A fold of tissue, especially a synovial fold within a joint.

### **Plummer-Vinson Syndrome**

Iron-deficiency anemia with dysphagia and esophageal webs, associated with increased upper gastrointestinal cancer risk.

### **Pluripotentia**

Capable of differentiating into many, but not all, cell types.

### **Plutonium**

A radioactive heavy metal whose inhalation or ingestion can cause internal radiation exposure and toxicity.

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## **Pm**

An abbreviation that may mean afternoon, post-mortem, or picometer; meaning depends on clinical context.

## **Pneumatic**

Operating by air or gas pressure.

## **Pneumatic Tourniquet**

An inflatable cuff used to temporarily reduce blood flow to a limb during surgery or selected procedures.

## **Pneumatocele**

A thin-walled, air-filled cavity in the lung, often developing after infection or trauma.

## **Pneumatosis**

Presence of gas within a tissue or organ wall, such as pneumatosis intestinalis.

## **Pneumoconiosis**

A group of occupational lung diseases caused by inhalation of mineral or industrial dusts.

## **Pneumocystis Carinii Pneumonia**

The historical name for *Pneumocystis jirovecii* pneumonia, an opportunistic lung infection in immunocompromised people.

## **Pneumocyte**

An epithelial cell lining the alveoli; type I cells exchange gases and type II cells produce surfactant.

## **Pneumoencephalography**

An obsolete imaging procedure that replaced cerebrospinal fluid with air to outline the brain on X-ray.

## **Pneumolysis**

Surgical separation or freeing of lung tissue or pleural adhesions.

## **Pneumomediastinum**

Air within the mediastinum, caused by trauma, rupture, barotrauma, or air tracking from the lungs or

neck.

## **Pneumonectomy**

Surgical removal of an entire lung.

## **Pneumonia**

Infection or inflammation of lung tissue causing symptoms such as cough, fever, breathlessness, and abnormal imaging.

## **Pneumonitis**

Inflammation of lung tissue, often from immune, drug, radiation, aspiration, or environmental causes rather than infection.

## **Pneumoperitoneum**

Air or gas within the peritoneal cavity, commonly from perforated bowel or abdominal surgery.

## **Pneumothorax**

Air in the pleural space causing partial or complete lung collapse.

## **Podagra**

Acute gout affecting the first metatarsophalangeal joint, causing severe pain, redness, and swelling.

## **Podiatrist**

A healthcare professional specializing in disorders of the feet and lower limbs.

## **Podiatry**

The healthcare field concerned with the feet, ankles, and related lower-limb disorders.

## **Podophyllum**

A plant genus containing podophyllotoxin, used in some topical wart treatments but toxic if misused.

## **Poikilocytosis**

Variation in the shape of red blood cells.

## **Poikilotherm**

An organism whose body temperature varies sub-

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stantially with environmental temperature; humans are homeothermic.

### **Point**

A specific location, spot, or value; in medicine it may refer to a tender point, pressure point, or measurement point.

### **Poison**

A substance capable of causing injury, illness, or death when absorbed in sufficient amount.

### **Poisoning**

Harmful effects caused by exposure to a toxic substance.

### **Poisson Distribution**

A probability distribution modeling the number of events occurring in a fixed interval when events occur independently at a stable average rate.

### **Polar**

Relating to a pole, direction, or molecule with separated electrical charges.

### **Polarity**

The distribution or orientation of positive and negative electrical or biological properties.

### **Poliomyelitis**

An infection caused by poliovirus, usually spread by the fecal-oral route. Most infections are asymptomatic or cause a mild febrile illness, but some cause meningitis or damage to anterior-horn motor neurons, resulting in acute asymmetric flaccid paralysis and sometimes permanent weakness.

### **Politzerization**

A historical method of inflating the middle ear through the nose during swallowing to improve Eustachian-tube ventilation.

### **Pollakiuria**

Abnormally frequent urination, often in small amounts.

### **Pollen**

Fine grains released by plants that can trigger allergic rhinitis, asthma, or conjunctivitis.

### **Pollex**

The thumb.

### **Pollution**

Contamination of air, water, soil, or surroundings by substances that may harm health or ecosystems.

### **Poly-**

A combining form meaning many or much.

### **Polyarthrititis**

Inflammation or disease affecting multiple joints.

### **Polyarteritis**

Inflammation of multiple arteries; polyarteritis nodosa is a systemic necrotizing vasculitis.

### **Polychromasia**

Presence of immature, bluish red blood cells in peripheral blood, reflecting increased marrow release.

### **Polycystic Kidney Disease**

An inherited disorder in which numerous kidney cysts enlarge the kidneys and may cause hypertension and renal failure.

#### **Synonyms:**

PKD

### **Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS)**

A common endocrine disorder involving ovulatory dysfunction, androgen excess, and polycystic ovarian morphology in varying combinations.

### **Polycythaemia**

An increased red-cell mass or concentration, which may be primary or secondary to another condition.

### **Polydactyly**

Presence of extra fingers or toes.

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**Polydipsia**

Excessive thirst or drinking.

**Polyethylene Glycol**

A polymer used as an osmotic laxative, excipient, and in various medical products.

**Polygenic**

Influenced by or caused by variants in multiple genes.

**Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR)**

A laboratory method that amplifies selected DNA sequences for detecting organisms or genetic variants.

**Polymagia**

Excessive hunger or eating.

**Polymastia**

The presence of extra breast tissue or additional nipples.

**Polymenorrhoea**

Menstrual bleeding occurring at unusually short intervals.

**Polymorphism**

The occurrence of two or more genetic forms or phenotypes in a population.

**Polymyxin**

A group of antibiotics that disrupt bacterial cell membranes, used mainly for selected gram-negative infections.

**Polymyalgia Rheumatica**

An inflammatory disorder causing aching and morning stiffness around the shoulders and hips in older adults.

**Synonyms:**

PMR (Polymyalgia Rheumatica)

**Polymyositis**

An autoimmune inflammatory muscle disease causing symmetric proximal muscle weakness.

**Synonyms:**

PM (Polymyositis)

**Polypeptide**

A chain of amino acids linked by peptide bonds.

**Polyposis**

A condition in which numerous polyps develop, especially in the gastrointestinal tract.

**Polyradiculitis**

Inflammation or disease affecting multiple spinal nerve roots.

**Polysaccharide**

A carbohydrate composed of many linked monosaccharide units.

**Polysomia**

The presence of extra copies of one or more chromosomes or, in developmental terminology, multiple body structures.

**Polythelia**

The presence of one or more additional nipples.

**Polyuria**

Excessive urine production, commonly more than about 3 liters per day in an adult.

**Polyvalent**

Effective against or involving multiple types, strains, antigens, or targets.

**Pompholyx**

A form of dyshidrotic eczema causing intensely itchy small blisters on the hands or feet.

**Pons**

The middle part of the brainstem, containing pathways and nuclei involved in movement, sensation,



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breathing, and cranial-nerve function.

### **Pontine**

Relating to the pons.

### **Popliteal**

Relating to the back of the knee.

### **Pore**

A small opening in the skin or another surface, often associated with a gland or follicle.

### **Porencephaly**

A cavity or cyst within the brain, usually caused by developmental abnormality or prenatal or acquired injury.

### **Pork Tapeworm**

*Taenia solium*, a tapeworm acquired from undercooked pork; its larvae can cause cysticercosis.

### **Porphria**

A misspelling of porphyria, a group of disorders involving abnormal heme synthesis.

### **Porphyria**

A group of inherited or acquired disorders caused by defects in heme biosynthesis, producing neurologic, abdominal, or skin symptoms.

### **Porphyrin**

A ring-shaped compound involved in heme and other biological molecules; abnormal accumulation occurs in porphyrias.

### **Port-Wine Stain**

A permanent capillary malformation producing a flat pink, red, or purple skin patch.

### **Position**

The location or posture of a body part, organ, fetus, or patient.

### **Positive Feedback**

A regulatory process in which an output amplifies the process that produced it, as in labor contractions.

### **Positron Emission Tomography (PET)**

Imaging that detects paired photons from a positron-emitting tracer to map metabolism or molecular activity.

### **Post-**

A combining form meaning after or behind.

### **Post-Concussional Syndrome**

Persistent physical, cognitive, emotional, or sleep symptoms after a concussion or mild traumatic brain injury.

### **Posterior**

Situated behind or toward the back of the body or a structure.

### **Post-Hoc**

Performed or analyzed after an event; in statistics, a post-hoc analysis follows the planned primary analysis.

### **Posthumous**

Occurring or published after a person's death.

### **Post-Mortem**

Occurring after death or relating to examination of a body after death.

### **Postnatal**

Relating to the period after birth.

### **Postpartum Depression**

A depressive episode occurring during pregnancy or after childbirth, causing significant distress or impairment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Depression, Postpartum PPD (Postpartum Depression)

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### **Postpartum Haemorrhage**

Excessive bleeding after childbirth, commonly defined by blood loss of at least 1,000 mL or bleeding with hypovolemia after birth.

### **Post-Prandial**

Occurring after a meal.

### **Postural Drainage**

Positioning a person so gravity assists drainage of secretions from selected parts of the lungs.

### **Postural Hypotension**

A significant fall in blood pressure on standing, often causing dizziness or fainting.

### **Posture**

The alignment and position of the body at rest or during activity.

### **Potassium**

An essential intracellular electrolyte important for nerve conduction, muscle contraction, and cardiac rhythm.

### **Potassium Permanganate**

An oxidizing antiseptic used in very dilute topical solutions; concentrated material can burn tissue.

### **Potassium-Sparing Diuretic**

A diuretic that promotes sodium excretion while reducing potassium loss, such as spironolactone or amiloride.

### **Pott's Disease**

Tuberculosis of the spine, causing vertebral destruction, back pain, deformity, or neurologic compromise.

### **Pott's Fracture**

An ankle fracture-dislocation involving the malleoli, historically defined variably.

### **Pouch**

A sac-like anatomical structure or surgically created reservoir.

### **Poultice**

A soft, moist substance applied to the body, historically to soothe or draw fluid from tissue.

### **Pound**

A unit of weight or pressure; the exact meaning depends on context.

### **Poverty**

Insufficient material resources to meet basic needs, a social determinant strongly affecting health and access to care.

### **Pox**

A disease producing vesicles, pustules, or pitted scars; the term is used in names such as smallpox and cowpox.

### **Poxvirus**

A family of large DNA viruses that includes variola, vaccinia, mpox, and molluscum contagiosum viruses.

### **Practitioner**

A person qualified and authorized to practice a healthcare profession.

### **Pragmatic**

Focused on practical outcomes or real-world effectiveness.

### **Pramipexole**

A dopamine agonist used mainly for Parkinson disease and restless legs syndrome.

### **Prasugrel**

An antiplatelet P2Y<sub>12</sub> inhibitor used in selected patients with acute coronary syndrome undergoing PCI.

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**Pravastatin**

A statin that lowers LDL cholesterol by inhibiting HMG-CoA reductase.

**Praziquantel**

An anthelmintic used for schistosomiasis and several tapeworm and fluke infections.

**Pre-**

A combining form meaning before or in front of.

**Pre-Cancerous**

Showing cellular changes that may progress to cancer but are not invasive cancer.

**Precaution**

An action taken to reduce risk of harm, infection, or error.

**Preclinical**

Before human clinical testing or relating to disease changes before symptoms become evident.

**Precocious Puberty**

Onset of secondary sexual characteristics earlier than the accepted normal age range.

**Synonyms:**

Early Puberty Premature Puberty

**Pre-Eclampsia**

New-onset hypertension after 20 weeks of pregnancy with proteinuria or other maternal organ or placental dysfunction.

**Prefrontal**

Relating to the anterior part of the frontal lobe involved in planning, judgment, working memory, and behavior.

**Pregnancy Test**

A test detecting human chorionic gonadotropin in urine or blood to identify pregnancy.

**Preleukaemia**

An obsolete term formerly used for myelodysplastic syndromes or other states preceding leukemia.

**Premalignant**

Having cellular or tissue changes that may progress to invasive cancer.

**Premature**

Occurring earlier than expected or before the usual developmental or gestational time.

**Premature Ejaculation**

Ejaculation that occurs sooner than desired with poor control and causes persistent personal or relationship distress.

**Premature Infant**

An infant born before 37 completed weeks of gestation.

**Premature Menopause**

Loss of ovarian function and menstruation before age 40, now often termed primary ovarian insufficiency.

**Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder (PMDD)**

A severe cyclical mood disorder with affective and physical symptoms in the luteal phase that remit after menstruation.

**Synonyms:**

PMDD (Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder (PMDD))

**Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS)**

Recurring physical, emotional, or behavioral symptoms before menstruation that resolve around or after its onset.

**Premolar**

A tooth between the canine and molar teeth.

**Prepuce**

The fold of skin covering the glans penis or clitoris;

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penile prepuce is the foreskin.

### **Presbyacusis**

Age-related progressive sensorineural hearing loss, usually affecting high frequencies.

### **Presbyopia**

Age-related loss of near focusing caused by reduced lens accommodation.

### **Prescription**

A written or electronic instruction from an authorized prescriber for a medicine or treatment.

### **Presenile Dementia**

An older term for dementia beginning before old age; modern diagnosis specifies the cause and syndrome.

### **Presentation**

The part of a fetus that is directed toward the birth canal, or the symptoms and signs with which a patient seeks care.

### **Preservation**

Maintenance of tissue, cells, organs, or function by preventing deterioration.

### **Preservative**

A substance added to prevent microbial growth or chemical deterioration of a product.

### **Pressor**

Raising blood pressure, usually by constricting blood vessels or increasing cardiac output.

### **Pressure**

Force exerted over an area; clinically measured in units such as mmHg.

### **Pressure Sore**

A localized injury to skin and underlying tissue caused by prolonged pressure or shear, also called a pressure ulcer.

### **Pre-Synaptic**

Situated before a synapse, especially the nerve-terminal side that releases a neurotransmitter.

### **Pretibial Myxoedema**

Thickened, waxy swelling of the skin over the shins, most often associated with Graves disease.

### **Prevalence**

The proportion of a population with a disease or characteristic at a specified time or period.

### **Prevention**

Measures intended to avoid disease, detect it early, limit complications, or reduce disability.

### **Preventive Medicine**

The field concerned with preventing disease and promoting health in individuals and populations.

### **Priapism**

A persistent, usually painful erection unrelated to sexual stimulation and lasting long enough to require urgent assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ischemic Priapism Low-Flow Priapism Nonischemic Priapism

### **Prickle Cell**

An obsolete or imprecise term sometimes used for a dendritic epidermal cell or for a sickle cell; the intended meaning requires context.

### **Prickly Heat**

Miliaria, an itchy rash caused by blockage of sweat ducts.

### **Primary**

First in time, origin, importance, or site; in disease classification it often means arising independently rather than secondary to another cause.

### **Primary Care**

First-contact, continuing, comprehensive healthcare, including prevention and management of common

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conditions.

### **Primary Lactase Deficiency**

Reduced lactase enzyme activity developing with age, causing lactose malabsorption and possible bloating, abdominal pain, gas, or diarrhea after dairy consumption.

### **Prokinetic**

A medicine that promotes gastrointestinal motility and movement of contents through the digestive tract; use depends on the underlying disorder and safety profile.

### **Primipara**

A person who has given birth once after the stage of fetal viability.

### **Primitive**

Relating to an early developmental stage or a basic, less differentiated form.

### **Primordial**

Existing at the earliest stage of development.

### **Prion**

An abnormally folded infectious protein that can cause progressive neurodegenerative disease.

### **Prism**

A transparent optical device that bends light; prisms may correct or measure ocular alignment.

### **PR Interval**

The ECG interval from the start of atrial depolarization to the start of ventricular depolarization, reflecting atrioventricular conduction.

### **Pro-**

A combining form meaning before, forward, or in favor of.

### **Probenecid**

A uricosuric medicine used to prevent gout attacks in selected patients and to alter renal excretion of

some drugs.

### **Prob Problem**

An incomplete or nonstandard label; its intended clinical meaning cannot be determined without source context.

### **Problem**

A symptom, sign, diagnosis, or issue requiring assessment or management.

### **Probocis**

A misspelling of proboscis, a projecting snout or appendage.

### **Proboscis**

An elongated nose, snout, or tubular feeding organ.

### **Procainamide**

An antiarrhythmic medicine used for selected cardiac rhythm disorders.

### **Procaine**

An ester local anesthetic, now used mainly in limited or historical settings.

### **Procarbazine**

An alkylating-like chemotherapy medicine used in selected lymphomas and brain tumors.

### **Prochlorperazine**

A phenothiazine medicine used as an antiemetic and antipsychotic.

### **Proctalgia**

Pain in or around the anus or rectum.

### **Proctitis**

Inflammation of the rectal lining.

### **Synonyms:**

Rectal Inflammation

### **Proctoclysis**

Administration of fluid into the rectum, an obsolete

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method of fluid or medicine delivery.

### **Proctology**

The medical specialty concerned with diseases of the anus and rectum.

### **Proctoscope**

An instrument used to inspect the anal canal and rectum.

### **Proctoscopy**

Examination of the anal canal and rectum with a proctoscope.

### **Proctostomy**

Surgical creation of an opening from the rectum to the skin.

### **Prodrome**

An early symptom or group of symptoms preceding a disease or major clinical event.

### **Productive Cough**

A cough that brings up sputum or phlegm.

### **Profession**

A skilled occupation requiring specialized education and ethical standards.

### **Professional**

Relating to a trained occupation or to the conduct expected of a qualified practitioner.

### **Profunda**

A deep artery or vessel, commonly referring to the profunda femoris artery.

### **Progenitor**

A cell that has partially differentiated and can give rise to one or more mature cell types.

### **Progeny**

Offspring or descendants.

### **Progeria**

A rare genetic disorder causing features of accelerated aging beginning in childhood.

### **Progestational**

Relating to progesterone-like effects or to preparation of the uterus for pregnancy.

### **Progesterone**

A steroid hormone produced mainly by the corpus luteum and placenta that supports the endometrium and pregnancy.

### **Progestogen**

A natural or synthetic hormone with progesterone-like effects.

### **Proglottid**

A segment of a tapeworm containing reproductive organs.

### **Prognosis**

The expected course and outcome of a disease or condition.

### **Program**

A planned set of activities or services, such as a screening or rehabilitation program.

### **Progressive**

Increasing or worsening over time, or advancing in a specified direction.

### **Progressive Lenticular Degeneration**

Wilson disease, an inherited copper-accumulation disorder affecting the liver, brain, and eyes.

### **Progressive Muscular Atrophy**

A motor-neuron disorder predominantly affecting lower motor neurons and causing progressive muscle wasting and weakness.

### **Projection**

The act of extending, displaying, or estimating some-



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thing; in imaging, a view produced by directing rays through a body.

### **Prolactin**

A pituitary hormone that stimulates breast development and milk production and influences reproductive function.

### **Prolactinoma**

A usually benign pituitary adenoma that secretes excess prolactin.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pituitary Tumor (Prolactinoma)

### **Prolapse**

Descent or displacement of an organ from its normal position.

### **Proliferation**

Rapid increase in the number of cells or organisms.

### **Proliferative**

Characterized by cell multiplication or new tissue growth.

### **Proline**

A protein-forming amino acid with a cyclic side chain.

### **Promazine**

A phenothiazine antipsychotic with sedative properties.

### **Promontory**

A projecting anatomical prominence, such as the sacral or cochlear promontory.

### **Promoters**

DNA regions that initiate transcription of a gene when bound by regulatory proteins.

### **Pronation**

Rotation of the forearm so the palm faces posteriorly or downward, or a related foot movement.

### **Pronephros**

The earliest embryonic kidney structure, which is nonfunctional in humans and largely regresses.

### **Pronator**

A muscle that turns a limb or part of it into a pronated position.

### **Prontosil**

An early sulfonamide antibacterial drug, historically important in antimicrobial therapy.

### **Propanolol**

A nonselective beta-adrenergic blocker used for hypertension, arrhythmias, angina, tremor, migraine prevention, and other indications.

### **Propantheline**

An antimuscarinic medicine formerly used for gastrointestinal spasm or excessive sweating.

### **Prophylaxis**

Treatment or preventive measures intended to reduce the risk of disease or infection.

### **Propofol**

A short-acting intravenous anesthetic used for induction and maintenance of anesthesia and procedural sedation.

### **Propranolol**

A nonselective beta blocker used for cardiovascular conditions, tremor, migraine prevention, and other indications.

### **Proprioception**

Awareness of body position and movement from receptors in muscles, tendons, joints, and skin.

### **Proprioceptor**

A sensory receptor that detects position, movement, or muscle stretch.

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**Propulsion**

The act of driving or moving something forward; in Parkinson disease, propulsion may be impaired.

**Proptosis**

Forward displacement or bulging of an eye.

**Propylthiouracil**

An antithyroid medicine that inhibits thyroid hormone synthesis and peripheral conversion of T4 to T3.

**Prosopagnosia**

Inability to recognize familiar faces despite otherwise adequate vision.

**Prostaglandins**

Locally acting lipid mediators involved in pain, inflammation, vascular tone, gastric protection, and reproductive physiology.

**Prostate**

A gland below the bladder surrounding the proximal urethra that contributes fluid to semen.

**Prostatectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the prostate.

**Prostate Gland**

The prostate, a gland below the bladder that surrounds the urethra and contributes secretions to semen.

**Prostate-Specific Antigen (PSA)**

A kallikrein-related enzyme measured in blood to assess prostate disorders, with interpretation affected by benign and malignant conditions.

**Prostatism**

Lower urinary-tract symptoms caused by bladder-outlet obstruction or dysfunction, often associated with prostate enlargement.

**Prostatitis**

Inflammation or infection of the prostate, causing pelvic pain, urinary symptoms, or systemic illness.

**Prosthesis**

An artificial device replacing or supporting a missing body part or function.

**Prosthetic**

Relating to or made by a prosthesis.

**Prostrate**

Lying flat or face downward; not to be confused with prostate.

**Protamine**

A strongly basic protein used to reverse the anticoagulant effect of heparin.

**Protease**

An enzyme that breaks down proteins by cleaving peptide bonds.

**Protective**

Serving to prevent or reduce injury, infection, or other harm.

**Protein**

A molecule made of amino acids that performs structural, enzymatic, transport, signaling, or immune functions.

**Proteinuria**

Abnormally high protein excretion in urine, often indicating kidney disease but also occurring transiently.

**Proteolysis**

Breakdown of proteins into smaller peptides or amino acids.

**Proteolytic**

Relating to or causing protein breakdown.

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**Proteus**

A genus of gram-negative bacteria that can cause urinary and wound infections.

**Prothrombin**

A vitamin-K-dependent plasma protein converted to thrombin during blood coagulation.

**Prothrombin Time**

A blood test assessing the extrinsic and common coagulation pathways, commonly reported as INR.

**Protozoa**

Single-celled eukaryotic organisms, some of which cause human disease.

**Protractile**

Capable of being extended or protruded.

**Protractor**

An instrument or muscle that moves a structure forward or outward.

**Protrusion**

A part that projects outward or a disc or tissue displaced beyond its normal boundary.

**Provisional Diagnosis**

A working diagnosis made before all information is available and subject to revision.

**Provocation**

An action or stimulus that triggers a symptom, response, or test finding.

**Proximal**

Closer to the point of attachment or to the center of the body than another structure.

**Prurigo**

A group of intensely itchy skin disorders with papules or nodules caused by inflammation and scratching.

**Pruritus**

Itching, an unpleasant skin sensation that creates the desire to scratch.

**Prussian Blue**

A blue pigment used in laboratory staining and as an antidote for selected radioactive cesium or thallium poisoning.

**Psalterium**

The body of the fornix in the brain, also called the hippocampal commissure; historically, a book of psalms.

**Psammoma**

A tumor or lesion containing concentrically laminated calcified bodies called psammoma bodies.

**Psychiatry**

A misspelling of psychiatry, the medical specialty concerned with mental disorders.

**Pseudarthrosis**

Failure of a fracture to unite, producing a false joint or persistent abnormal mobility.

**Pseudo-**

A combining form meaning false or resembling but not truly.

**Pseudocyesis**

A false belief or physical state resembling pregnancy without a fetus.

**Pseudodementia**

Cognitive symptoms caused by depression or another potentially reversible condition rather than primary neurodegeneration.

**Pseudohypertrophic Muscular Dystrophy**

An older name for Duchenne or related muscular dystrophy with enlarged-appearing muscles caused by fat and connective tissue.

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## **Pseudomonas**

A genus of gram-negative bacteria, including *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, that can cause opportunistic infections.

## **Pseudoneurosis**

An obsolete term for symptoms resembling neurosis but caused by an underlying physical disorder.

## **Pseudorabies**

Aujeszky disease, a herpesvirus infection of animals; humans are rare accidental hosts.

## **Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum**

An inherited connective-tissue disorder with mineralization and fragmentation of elastic fibers, affecting skin, eyes, and blood vessels.

### **Synonyms:**

PXE (Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum)

## **Psittacosis**

A zoonotic infection caused by *Chlamydia psittaci*, usually acquired from infected birds.

## **Psoas**

A major hip-flexor muscle running from the lumbar spine to the femur.

## **Psoriasis**

A chronic immune-mediated skin disease producing sharply demarcated, often scaly plaques.

## **Psychasthenia**

An obsolete term for obsessive doubts, compulsive thoughts, or an inability to direct attention.

## **Psychedelic**

Producing altered perception, mood, and cognition, as with certain hallucinogenic substances.

## **Psychiatry**

The medical specialty concerned with mental health and the diagnosis and treatment of mental disorders.

## **Psychic**

Relating to the mind or mental processes; claims of supernatural perception are not medical findings.

## **Psychoactive**

Affecting mood, thought, perception, behavior, or other mental processes.

## **Psychoanalysis**

A historical psychological theory and treatment approach emphasizing unconscious processes and conflicts.

## **Psychodrama**

A therapeutic method using guided dramatic enactment to explore emotions, relationships, and behavior.

## **Psychological**

Relating to mental processes, emotions, behavior, or their effects on health.

## **Psychology**

The scientific study of behavior and mental processes.

### **Synonyms:**

Mental Health (Psychology)

## **Psychometrics**

The measurement of psychological characteristics using standardized tests and statistical methods.

## **Psychomotor**

Relating to the interaction of mental processes and physical movement.

## **Psychoneurosis**

An obsolete term for a nonpsychotic emotional disorder, historically including anxiety and phobic conditions.

## **Psychopathic**

Relating to severe, persistent antisocial personality traits; the term is often used imprecisely.

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## **Psychopathology**

The study or description of abnormal mental states and behavior.

## **Psychopharmacology**

The study of how drugs affect behavior, mood, cognition, and other mental processes.

## **Psychosexual**

Relating to psychological and sexual development or functioning.

## **Psychosis**

A state involving impaired reality testing, such as delusions, hallucinations, or disorganized thought.

## **Psychosurgery**

Surgery intended to alter brain circuits for severe, treatment-resistant psychiatric illness; it is rarely used and highly specialized.

## **Psychotherapy**

Structured psychological treatment using therapeutic communication and evidence-based techniques.

## **Psychotic**

Relating to or characterized by psychosis.

## **Pterygium**

A wing-shaped growth of conjunctival tissue extending onto the cornea, usually related to ultraviolet exposure.

## **Ptilosis**

Abnormal growth, loss, or condition of hair or feathers; the exact meaning depends on context.

## **Ptoxis**

Drooping of an eyelid or another body structure.

## **Ptyalin**

An older name for salivary amylase, the enzyme that begins starch digestion in the mouth.

## **Ptyalism**

Excessive salivation.

## **Puberty**

The developmental period in which hormonal changes produce sexual maturation and reproductive capability.

## **Pubes**

The pubic region or pubic hair.

## **Pubic**

Relating to the pubis or the region over the front of the pelvis.

## **Pubis**

The front part of the pelvic bone, meeting its opposite side at the pubic symphysis.

## **Pudendal**

Relating to the external genitalia or perineum.

## **Puerperal**

Relating to the period after childbirth, usually the first six weeks.

## **Puerperal Fever**

Fever and infection occurring after childbirth, often from uterine or genital-tract infection.

## **Puerperium**

The approximately six-week period after childbirth during which the reproductive organs return toward their nonpregnant state.

## **Pulex**

A genus of fleas, including *Pulex irritans*.

## **Pulex Irritans**

The human flea, which can cause bites and occasionally transmit infections.

## **Pulmonary Artery**

The artery carrying deoxygenated blood from the

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right ventricle to the lungs.

### **Pulmonary Embolism**

Blockage of a pulmonary artery, usually by a clot that traveled from a deep vein.

#### **Synonyms:**

Blood Clot In The Lung (Pulmonary Embolism)  
Embolism Pulmonary (Pulmonary Embolism)

### **Pulmonary Oedema**

Accumulation of fluid in lung tissue or alveoli, causing breathlessness and impaired gas exchange.

### **Pulmonary Stenosis**

Narrowing of the pulmonary valve or outflow tract, obstructing blood flow from the right ventricle.

### **Pulmonary Tuberculosis**

Tuberculosis infection involving the lungs, caused by *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*.

### **Pulp**

The soft vascular and nervous tissue inside a tooth or, in plants, soft internal tissue.

### **Pulpitis**

Inflammation of the dental pulp, usually caused by caries, trauma, cracks, or restorative treatment. Reversible pulpitis causes brief pain provoked by cold or sweet stimuli; irreversible pulpitis causes spontaneous or lingering pain and may progress to pulp necrosis, requiring endodontic treatment or extraction.

### **Pulse**

The rhythmic expansion of an artery produced by each heartbeat.

### **Pulseless Disease**

Takayasu arteritis, a large-vessel vasculitis that can reduce pulses in affected arteries.

### **Pulsus**

A Latin term for pulse, used in names describing abnormal pulse patterns.

### **Pumice**

A porous volcanic stone used as an abrasive; excessive dust inhalation can irritate the lungs.

### **Puna**

A high-altitude region or, in some sources, a term related to altitude sickness; precise meaning depends on context.

### **Punch-Drunk**

An obsolete term for chronic traumatic encephalopathy associated with repeated head injury, especially in boxing.

### **Punctate**

Composed of or marked by small spots or points.

### **Puncture**

A wound or procedure made by a pointed object or needle.

### **Pungent**

Having a strong, sharp smell or taste; pungent substances may irritate mucous membranes.

### **Punicin**

A rare or historical term whose precise medical meaning is source-dependent and should be verified.

### **Pupil**

The central opening in the iris through which light enters the eye.

### **Pupillary**

Relating to the pupil.

### **Purge**

To empty the bowel, stomach, or body of a substance; the term may also mean forceful vomiting or diarrhea.

### **Purgative**

A substance that induces bowel evacuation.



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**Purine**

A nitrogen-containing compound forming part of nucleotides; its breakdown produces uric acid.

**Purkinje Fibres**

Specialized cardiac conduction fibers that rapidly distribute impulses through the ventricular myocardium.

**Purpura**

Purple or red nonblanching skin or mucosal discoloration caused by bleeding into tissue.

**Pus**

A thick fluid containing dead cells, bacteria, inflammatory cells, and tissue debris.

**Pustule**

A small, raised skin lesion filled with pus.

**Putrefaction**

Decomposition of tissues after death by bacterial and enzymatic processes.

**Putrescine**

A foul-smelling diamine produced during breakdown of proteins in decaying tissue.

**Pyelitis**

Inflammation of the renal pelvis, usually due to infection.

**Pyelogram**

An imaging record of the renal pelvis and ureters after contrast administration.

**Pyelography**

Imaging of the renal pelvis and ureters using contrast.

**Pyelolithotomy**

Surgical removal of a stone from the renal pelvis.

**Pyelonephritis**

Infection and inflammation of the kidney and renal pelvis, usually caused by ascending bacteria.

**Pyloric Stenosis**

Narrowing of the pyloric outlet, classically causing projectile vomiting in infants or gastric-outlet symptoms in adults.

**Synonyms:**

Stenosis, Pyloric

**Pyloroplasty**

Surgical widening of the pylorus to improve gastric emptying.

**Pylorus**

The distal part of the stomach leading into the duodenum.

**Pyoderma**

A bacterial skin infection producing pus, crusts, erosions, or ulcers.

**Pyogenesis**

Formation of pus.

**Pyogenic**

Producing pus or associated with pus-forming infection.

**Pyometra**

Accumulation of pus within the uterus.

**Pyosalpinx**

Accumulation of pus within a fallopian tube, usually due to pelvic infection.

**Pyramid**

A pyramid-shaped structure; in neuroanatomy, the medullary pyramids contain corticospinal fibers.

**Pyramidal Tracts**

Descending motor pathways from the cerebral cortex to the brainstem and spinal cord.

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**Pyramidon**

An obsolete analgesic and antipyretic medicine, also called aminopyrine.

**Pyrazinamide**

An antituberculous medicine used in combination therapy, especially during the initial phase.

**Pyrethrins**

Natural insecticides derived from chrysanthemum flowers; exposure can irritate skin and airways.

**Pyrethrum**

A plant-derived insecticide source containing pyrethrins.

**Pyrexia**

Fever or an elevated body temperature.

**Pyridostigmine**

An acetylcholinesterase inhibitor used mainly for myasthenia gravis and selected neuromuscular disorders.

**Pyrimethamine**

An antiparasitic medicine that inhibits folate metabolism and is used for selected protozoal infections.

**Pyrosis**

Heartburn, a burning discomfort behind the breastbone caused commonly by reflux of gastric contents.

**Pyuria**

Presence of white blood cells or pus in urine, often indicating urinary-tract inflammation or infection.

**Synonyms:**

Artificial pacemaker

**Pacemaker, Natural**

The sinoatrial node, whose cells normally initiate the heartbeat.

**Synonyms:**

Sinoatrial node

**PAD**

Peripheral artery disease caused by narrowed arteries, usually affecting the legs.

**Synonyms:**

Peripheral artery disease

**Painkillers**

Medicines or other treatments that relieve pain.

**Synonyms:**

Analgesics

**Palpate**

To examine body tissues by carefully feeling them with the hands.

**Synonyms:**

Palpation

**PCP**

Pneumocystis jirovecii pneumonia (formerly Pneumocystis carinii pneumonia); opportunistic infection in immunocompromised patients, especially transplant recipients.

**Pelvic Floor**

A group of muscles and connective tissues supporting the pelvic organs and controlling urinary and fecal continence.

**Pepsin**

A stomach enzyme that begins digestion of proteins.

**Percutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation**

Electrical stimulation delivered through the skin to reduce pain signals.

**Synonyms:**

PENS

**Percutaneous Transluminal Coronary Angioplasty**

Balloon-based treatment that widens a narrowed coronary artery, often followed by stent placement.

**Synonyms:**

PTCA; balloon angioplasty

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### **Performance Anxiety**

Anxiety about sexual performance that can interfere with sexual function.

### **Periodic Limb Movement Disorder**

Repeated involuntary limb movements during sleep that may disrupt rest.

#### **Synonyms:**

PLMD Sleep Disorder Periodic Limb Movement (Periodic Limb Movement Disorder)

### **Periodization**

Planned variation of exercise volume and intensity over time.

### **Peripheral Vascular Disease**

Disease involving narrowed or blocked blood vessels outside the heart and brain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peripheral arterial disease PVD (Peripheral Vascular Disease)

### **Peripheral Vision**

The portion of the visual field outside the direct line of sight.

#### **Synonyms:**

Side vision

### **Personal Emergency Response System**

A wearable or nearby device that lets a person summon help during an emergency.

#### **Synonyms:**

Medical alert system

### **Pessimism**

A tendency to expect negative outcomes or interpret situations unfavorably.

### **Peyronie's Disease**

Scar tissue within the penis that can cause curvature and pain during erection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peyronie disease

### **Phantom Limb**

The sensation that an amputated limb is still present, sometimes with pain.

#### **Synonyms:**

Phantom-limb sensation

### **Phlebotomy**

The collection of blood from a vein, usually with a needle.

#### **Synonyms:**

Venipuncture

### **Photoreceptors**

Specialized retinal cells that detect light; rods and cones are the two main types.

### **Physician Assistant**

A licensed clinician who evaluates patients and provides medical care under a physician's practice framework.

#### **Synonyms:**

PA

### **Pigment**

A substance that gives tissue, hair, skin, or other material its color.

### **Piles**

Enlarged or swollen veins in the anus or lower rectum.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hemorrhoids

### **Pill**

A solid oral dosage form containing medicine or another active ingredient.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tablet

### **Plasma**

The liquid portion of blood in which blood cells and dissolved substances circulate.

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**Plasma Cells**

Mature B lymphocytes that produce antibodies.

**Platelets**

Small blood components that gather at damaged vessels and help form clots.

**Synonyms:**

Thrombocytes

**Polymenorrhea**

Menstrual bleeding occurring at unusually short intervals.

**Polyp**

A growth projecting from a mucous membrane; it may be benign, precancerous, or rarely cancerous.

**Positive Psychology**

The study of well-being, strengths, resilience, and factors that help people thrive.

**Posterior Chamber**

The part of the eye between the iris and lens, containing aqueous humor.

**Posterior Heel Bursitis**

Inflammation of a bursa near the back of the heel, causing pain and swelling.

**Synonyms:**

Retrocalcaneal bursitis

**Posterior Keyhole Foraminotomy**

A minimally invasive operation that enlarges a spinal nerve opening to relieve compression.

**Postpartum**

Relating to the period after childbirth.

**Synonyms:**

Postnatal

**Post-Traumatic Headache**

A headache that begins or persists after a head or neck injury.

**Power**

The rate at which work is performed; in exercise, it combines force and movement speed.

**Power Training**

Exercise designed to improve the ability to produce force rapidly.

**Synonyms:**

Explosive training

**Prazosin**

An alpha-1 blocker that relaxes blood vessels and smooth muscle.

**Precursor**

A substance that can be converted into another biologically active substance.

**Prehypertension**

Blood pressure above normal but below the former threshold for hypertension.

**Synonyms:**

Elevated blood pressure

**Preload Reduction**

Lowering the amount of blood returning to the heart to reduce cardiac workload.

**Premature Ventricular Contraction**

An early heartbeat arising from the ventricles.

**Synonyms:**

PVC

**Prick Test**

A skin test in which small amounts of suspected allergens are introduced into the skin.

**Synonyms:**

Skin-prick test

**Primary Angioplasty**

Angioplasty used as the initial treatment to reopen an artery during an acute heart attack.

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### **Primary Osteoporosis**

Bone loss due to aging, menopause, or other normal physiological processes rather than another disease.

### **Procurement**

Process of recovering organs and tissues from donors for transplantation.

### **Protocol**

A predefined plan specifying procedures for a clinical study, examination, or treatment.

### **PSA**

Prostate-specific antigen, a protein measured in blood to help evaluate prostate conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Prostate-specific antigen

### **PSA Velocity**

The rate at which PSA concentration changes over time.

### **Psychiatrist**

Physician specializing in diagnosis and treatment of mental disorders; involved in pre-transplant psychological evaluation and post-transplant mental health management.

### **Psychogenic**

Caused or substantially influenced by psychological factors.

### **Psychogenic Erectile Dysfunction**

Erectile difficulty primarily related to psychological factors rather than a structural disease.

### **Psychosomatic**

Relating to physical symptoms influenced by psychological processes or stress.

### **PTCA**

Percutaneous transluminal coronary angioplasty, a procedure that opens a narrowed coronary artery.

#### **Synonyms:**

Percutaneous coronary intervention

### **PTLD**

Post-transplant lymphoproliferative disorder; a spectrum of lymphoid proliferations ranging from benign hyperplasia to lymphoma, occurring in immunosuppressed transplant recipients.

### **Puborectalis Muscle**

A pelvic-floor muscle sling around the rectum that helps maintain continence.

### **Pudendal Arteries**

Arteries supplying blood to the external genital and perineal region.

### **Pudendal Nerve**

The nerve carrying sensation and motor signals to much of the perineum and pelvic floor.

### **Pulmonary**

Relating to the lungs.

### **Pulmonary Veins**

Veins carrying oxygen-rich blood from the lungs to the left atrium.

### **Pulse Pressure**

The difference between systolic and diastolic blood pressure.

### **Pump Failure**

Severe weakening of the heart's pumping ability, causing inadequate blood flow to organs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardiogenic pump failure

### **Purulent**

Containing or producing pus.

### **Pyloric Sphincter**

A muscular valve regulating passage of stomach contents into the duodenum.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Pylorus

### **Pyridoxine**

A form of vitamin B6 involved in metabolism and nervous-system function.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vitamin B6

### **P2Y12 Inhibitor**

An antiplatelet drug that blocks the platelet P2Y12 ADP receptor, reducing activation and aggregation. Clopidogrel, prasugrel, and ticagrelor are used in selected acute coronary syndrome and percutaneous coronary intervention settings, with bleeding and drug-specific contraindications considered.

### **P53 Tumor Suppressor**

The p53 protein, encoded by the TP53 gene on chromosome 17p, is a transcription factor and the most commonly mutated gene in human cancer, with mutations found in over 50 percent of all malignancies.

### **Pacemaker**

An implanted electronic device that delivers electrical impulses to the heart to regulate heart rate and rhythm. Indications include symptomatic bradycardia, high-degree AV block, and sick sinus syndrome. Single-chamber pacemakers pace the atrium or ventricle; dual-chamber pacemakers pace both.

### **Pacemaker Complications**

Early: pneumothorax, hematoma, cardiac perforation/tamponade, lead dislodgement. Late: lead fracture, battery depletion, infection, tricuspid regurgitation from lead interference, venous thrombosis, and pacemaker syndrome (AV dyssynchrony in VVI pacing).

### **Pachygyria**

A cortical malformation in which the cerebral gyri are abnormally broad and reduced in number because of impaired neuronal migration. It may cause developmental delay, intellectual disability, seizures, and motor or neurological impairment of variable severity.

### **Pachymeningitis**

Inflammation of the dura mater (pachymeninx), the outermost layer of the meninges. Pachymeningitis is less common than leptomeningitis (inflammation of pia and arachnoid mater).

### **Pacing**

Planned regulation of activity, rest, and intensity to avoid symptom exacerbation while gradually increasing tolerance. It is used in fatigue, chronic pain, cardiopulmonary disease, and post-viral conditions.

### **PACS**

Picture Archiving and Communication System. Digital image storage and retrieval.

### **PAD Management**

Atherosclerotic occlusive disease of arteries supplying the lower limbs, causing reduced blood flow. See peripheral arterial disease.

### **Page Kidney**

Renal compression from a perinephric hematoma or mass causing hypertension through activation of the renin-angiotensin system, typically following trauma or occurring in patients on anticoagulation.

### **Paget Disease Of Bone**

A chronic bone disorder characterized by excessive, disorganized bone remodeling with increased osteoclastic bone resorption followed by compensatory osteoblastic bone formation, producing structurally abnormal bone that is enlarged, weak, and prone to fracture.

### **Paget's Disease**

A chronic bone disorder characterized by excessive, disorganized bone remodeling with increased osteoclastic bone resorption followed by compensatory osteoblastic bone formation, producing structurally abnormal bone that is enlarged, weak, and prone to fracture. See Paget Disease of Bone.

#### **Synonyms:**

Osteitis Deformans (Paget's Disease) Pagets Disease (Paget's Disease) PDB (Paget's Disease)



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### **Paget Disease Of The Nipple**

A rare breast cancer involving the nipple and areola, often causing persistent eczema-like scaling, redness, itching, burning, or discharge. It may be associated with underlying ductal carcinoma in situ or invasive breast cancer.

### **Pain**

An unpleasant sensory and emotional experience associated with actual or potential tissue damage, serving as a protective alerting system but becoming maladaptive when chronic (lasting >3 months).

### **Pain (Geriatric)**

Pain in an older adult. Assessment considers communication, cognition, function, medicines, and possible causes; treatment is individualized to the person and condition.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Pain (Vascular)**

Pain caused by impaired blood flow, often appearing in a limb with exertion as claudication or, in more severe disease, at rest.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Pain Assessment Scales**

Pain assessment uses standardized scales to quantify pain intensity. Numeric rating scale (NRS) asks patients to rate pain from 0 (no pain) to 10 (worst pain imaginable). Visual analog scale (VAS) is a 10 cm line with anchors. Faces pain scale (Wong-Baker FACES) uses facial expressions for children and cognitively impaired patients.

### **Pain Management**

Assessment and treatment of pain using appropriate pharmacologic, physical, psychological, and interventional approaches. Treatment is individualized according to the cause, severity, duration, functional effect, and risks of each option.

### **Pain Relief (Analgesia)**

Achieved through pharmacologic, interventional, physical, and psychologic modalities targeting nociceptive transmission and pain perception.

#### **Synonyms:**

Analgesia

### **Pair Production**

Photon interaction producing electron-positron pair. Requires energy >1.022 MeV.

### **Paleness**

A clinical condition involving paleness; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Palindromic Rheumatism**

Characterized by recurrent, self-limited attacks of mono- or oligoarthritis (hours to days), periarticular soft tissue swelling, no radiographic erosions between attacks. 30-50% evolve to RA (anti-CCP positive predicts progression).

### **Palliative Care**

Specialized medical care for serious illness focusing on symptom relief and quality of life. Not limited to end-of-life. Can be provided alongside curative treatment. Components: pain management, symptom control, psychosocial support, spiritual care, advance care planning. Referral early in disease course.

### **Palliative Rehabilitation**

Rehabilitation for people with serious or life-limiting illness, focused on comfort, function, participation, symptom management, and quality of life.

### **Pallister-Hall Syndrome**

A congenital disorder usually caused by pathogenic variants in *GLI3*. It is characterized by hypothalamic hamartoma and mesoaxial polydactyly and may include imperforate anus, renal or airway anomalies, and pituitary hormone abnormalities.

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### Palmar Erythema Of Pregnancy

Symmetrical redness of the palms occurring during pregnancy, thought to be related to elevated circulating oestrogen levels causing vasodilatation. It is a benign, physiological finding that typically resolves after delivery and requires no specific treatment.

### Palmar Grasp Reflex

A primitive reflex in which an infant flexes the fingers around an object placed in the palm. It is normally present at birth and gradually diminishes as voluntary grasp develops; asymmetry or persistence may warrant neurologic assessment.

### Palpation

Examination by touching the body to assess tenderness, temperature, texture, masses, pulses, organ size, and movement.

### Palpebral Conjunctiva

The part of the conjunctiva that lines the inner surfaces of the eyelids. It joins the bulbar conjunctiva at the fornices and helps protect and lubricate the eye.

### Palpitation

The subjective sensation of a rapid, forceful, or irregular heartbeat. Palpitations are a common symptom with a broad differential.

### Palsy Of The Long Thoracic Nerve

Weakness or paralysis of the long thoracic nerve (C5-C7), which innervates the serratus anterior muscle. Causes include trauma, compression, viral infection, or idiopathic. Results in winging of the scapula, particularly when pushing against a wall, and impaired overhead arm elevation. Most cases resolve spontaneously.

### Pancoast Syndrome

A clinical syndrome caused by an apical lung tumour invading the lower brachial plexus, sympathetic chain, or adjacent structures. It may produce severe shoulder and arm pain, hand weakness, sensory loss, and Horner syndrome.

### Pancoast Tumor

Superior sulcus tumor invading brachial plexus, subclavian vessels, and sympathetic chain. Causes Horner syndrome, shoulder/arm pain, and hand muscle atrophy. Treated with chemoradiation followed by surgery.

### Pancreas

Retroperitoneal gland (15-20 cm) behind the stomach, spanning from duodenum to spleen. Exocrine function: acinar cells secrete digestive enzymes (amylase, lipase, proteases) and bicarbonate into pancreatic duct to duodenum.

### Pancreas Divisum

A congenital anomaly in which the dorsal and ventral pancreatic ducts fail to fuse. Most people are asymptomatic, but impaired drainage through the minor papilla can predispose to recurrent pancreatitis.

#### Synonyms:

Divisum Pancreas (Pancreas Divisum)

### Pancreatectomy

Removal of all (total) or part of the pancreas. Pancreaticoduodenectomy (Whipple) is used for pancreatic head and periampullary tumors; distal pancreatectomy for body and tail lesions.

### Pancreatic Abscess

A localized collection of pus within or adjacent to the pancreas, usually developing as a complication of infected pancreatic necrosis or severe pancreatitis. It may cause persistent fever, abdominal pain, sepsis, and organ failure.

### Pancreatic Adenocarcinoma

A malignant tumor arising from the exocrine ductal cells of the pancreas. It may cause jaundice, abdominal or back pain, weight loss, or no early symptoms; risk factors include smoking, chronic pancreatitis, diabetes, obesity, and inherited cancer syndromes.

### Pancreatic Cancer

Malignancy arising in the pancreas, most often pan-

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creatic ductal adenocarcinoma. Symptoms may include jaundice, abdominal or back pain, weight loss, or digestive problems, although early disease may be asymptomatic. Treatment depends on tumor type, extent, and patient factors.

**Synonyms:**

Cancer, Pancreatic

### **Pancreatic Duct**

The main duct of the pancreas, conveying exocrine pancreatic secretions to the duodenum. It commonly joins the common bile duct before opening at the major duodenal papilla.

### **Pancreatic Elastase**

A stool test that measures elastase-1 as an indirect estimate of pancreatic exocrine function. Low results support pancreatic exocrine insufficiency, but interpretation depends on stool consistency, the assay, and the clinical setting. Replacement pancreatic enzymes do not usually interfere with the test.

### **Pancreatic Enzyme**

Digestive enzymes secreted by pancreatic acinar cells into the duodenum, including proteases (trypsinogen, chymotrypsinogen, proelastase, procarboxypeptidases), amylase (starch digestion), and lipase (triglyceride digestion), along with bicarbonate from ductal cells to neutralize gastric acid.

### **Pancreatic Exocrine Insufficiency**

Inadequate secretion or delivery of pancreatic digestive enzymes and bicarbonate, causing maldigestion and malabsorption. Chronic pancreatitis, cystic fibrosis, pancreatic resection, and advanced pancreatic disease are important causes; steatorrhea and weight loss may respond to pancreatic enzyme replacement.

### **Pancreatic Insufficiency**

Inadequate production or delivery of pancreatic digestive enzymes, causing impaired digestion and absorption, weight loss, diarrhea, or fatty stools. Treatment may include pancreatic enzyme replacement and nutritional support.

### **Pancreatic Mass**

Abnormality in pancreas detected on imaging. Pancreatic adenocarcinoma most common malignancy. Neuroendocrine tumors also important.

### **Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumors**

Tumors arising from neuroendocrine cells of the pancreas. They may produce hormones, such as insulin or gastrin, or be nonfunctioning. Classification and prognosis use differentiation, grade, proliferation measures, stage, and clinical behavior.

**Synonyms:**

Islet Cell Cancer

### **Pancreatic Pseudocyst**

A pancreatic pseudocyst is a localized collection of pancreatic fluid surrounded by a wall of granulation tissue without an epithelial lining, typically occurring as a complication of acute or chronic pancreatitis. Unlike true cysts, pseudocysts lack an epithelial lining, which is why they are called pseudocysts.

### **Pancreatic Surgery**

Pancreaticoduodenectomy (Whipple): pancreatic head, duodenum, gallbladder, distal stomach (pylorus-preserving standard), common bile duct; reconstruction: pancreaticojejunostomy (duct-to-mucosa or invagination), hepaticojejunostomy, gastrojejunostomy/duodenojejunostomy.

### **Pancreatic Trauma**

Injury to the pancreas caused by blunt or penetrating trauma. Assessment may require CT, laboratory testing, and observation or intervention according to the injury.

### **Pancreatitis**

Inflammation of the pancreas that may be acute or chronic. Causes include gallstones, alcohol, medicines, metabolic disorders, and other conditions; severity ranges from mild to necrotizing disease.

**Synonyms:**

Inflamed Pancreas Pancreas Inflammation Pancreas Inflammation (Pancreatitis)

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### **Pancreatoblastoma**

A rare malignant pancreatic epithelial tumour occurring mainly in children. It may present with an abdominal mass, pain, vomiting, weight loss, or hormonal symptoms and requires imaging, tissue diagnosis, staging, and multidisciplinary treatment.

### **Pancreatography**

Contrast imaging of pancreatic duct. ERCP approach. Evaluates pancreatic duct abnormalities.

### **Pancytopenia**

Simultaneous reduction of red cells, white cells, and platelets, indicating bone marrow failure or infiltration.

### **PANDAS**

Pediatric autoimmune neuropsychiatric disorder associated with streptococcal infection, a proposed syndrome involving abrupt onset or worsening of obsessive-compulsive symptoms or tics in a child after infection. Diagnosis is clinical and remains controversial; evaluation should also consider common neurologic, psychiatric, and infectious causes.

### **Pandemic**

Epidemic spread across multiple countries/continents. Examples: COVID-19, Spanish flu, HIV/AIDS.

### **Paneth Cell**

Specialized secretory epithelial cell at the base of a small-intestinal crypt that produces antimicrobial substances.

### **Panic Attack**

An abrupt surge of intense fear or discomfort reaching a peak within minutes.

### **Panic Disorder**

Recurrent unexpected panic attacks, which are abrupt surges of intense fear or discomfort peaking within minutes.

### **Panlobular Emphysema**

A subtype involving diffuse destruction of the entire acinus. It predominantly affects the lower lobes and is classically associated with alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency. The destruction is more uniform compared to centriacinar emphysema.

### **Panniculitis**

Inflammation of the subcutaneous fat, presenting as tender, erythematous or violaceous nodules and plaques, most commonly on the lower extremities. The classification is based on whether the septa or lobules of the fat are primarily affected, and the aetiology includes infections, autoimmune diseases, medications, and pancreatic disease.

### **Panoramic Radiograph**

An extraoral radiograph displaying both jaws, teeth, temporomandibular regions, and surrounding structures in one image. It is useful for surveying dentition, development, impaction, and gross osseous pathology but has less fine detail than intraoral radiographs.

### **Panretinal Photocoagulation**

A laser treatment that applies scattered burns to the peripheral retina to reduce abnormal blood-vessel growth. It is used for selected proliferative retinal diseases, including proliferative diabetic retinopathy, and can affect peripheral or night vision.

### **Panuveitis**

Inflammation involving the anterior uvea, vitreous, and posterior uveal tissues. It can threaten vision and may be caused by infection, autoimmune disease, trauma, or other disorders; treatment depends on the cause and severity.

### **Pap Smear**

Papanicolaou test (cervical cytology): a screening test collecting cervical cells (conventional or liquid-based) to detect precancerous cervical changes (CIN) and cancer, usually combined with HPV DNA testing (co-testing).

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## Papillary Muscle

Muscular projections of the ventricular myocardium attached by chordae tendineae to the atrioventricular valve leaflets (anterolateral and posteromedial in the left ventricle; anterior, septal, and posterior in the right ventricle).

## Papillary Thyroid Carcinoma

Most common histological subtype of thyroid carcinoma accounting for approximately eighty percent of cases. Characterized by nuclear features including nuclear grooves, intranuclear cytoplasmic inclusions, and Orphan Annie eye nuclei. Often multifocal and bilateral with lymph node metastases.

## Papilledema

Swelling of the optic disc caused by elevated intracranial pressure, and it is a critical clinical sign that requires urgent investigation to identify the underlying cause, which may be life-threatening.

## Papilloma

A benign epithelial neoplasm characterised by finger-like projections of fibrovascular tissue covered by hyperplastic epithelium, most commonly caused by human papillomavirus infection in cutaneous warts or mucosal sites. Cutaneous papillomas present as flesh-coloured, rough, or pedunculated growths.

## Papillomatosis Cutis Lymphostatica

Diffuse, warty, papillomatous thickening of the skin resulting from chronic lymphoedema, most commonly affecting the lower extremities in the setting of long-standing venous or lymphatic insufficiency. The skin develops cobblestone-like hyperkeratotic papules and plaques due to lymph stasis and chronic inflammation.

## Papular

A papule: a small, solid, elevated skin lesion <1 cm in diameter (palpable), of various colors and etiologies.

## Papular Urticaria

A hypersensitivity reaction to insect bites, especially from fleas, bedbugs, or mosquitoes, causing recur-

rent intensely itchy papules or small vesicles, often clustered on exposed areas in children. Diagnosis is clinical.

## Paracentesis

Percutaneous needle aspiration of ascitic fluid from the peritoneal cavity. Used for diagnostic analysis to determine the cause of ascites and for therapeutic removal of large volumes for symptom relief. The serum-ascites albumin gradient is calculated to differentiate portal hypertensive from non-portal hypertensive causes.

## Paracetamol Overdose

Toxic ingestion of paracetamol that can cause dose-dependent hepatic necrosis; risk assessment uses the timing and serum concentration of the ingestion.

## Paracetamol Toxicity

Liver injury caused by excessive acetaminophen (paracetamol) exposure. Severe poisoning may cause nausea, abdominal pain, liver failure, or death and requires urgent assessment.

## Paraesophageal Hernia

A hiatal hernia in which part of the stomach moves through the diaphragm beside the esophagus. It may cause obstruction or strangulation even when reflux is absent.

## Paraganglioma

A neuroendocrine tumor arising from extra-adrenal paraganglia, related to pheochromocytoma; may secrete catecholamines. Associations with hereditary syndromes (SDH mutations, VHL, NF1) warrant genetic counseling.

## Paragonimiasis

A parasitic infection caused by *Paragonimus* lung flukes, usually acquired by eating undercooked crustaceans. It commonly affects the lungs.

## Parainfluenza

Parainfluenza viruses are respiratory viruses that commonly cause colds, croup, bronchitis, or pneu-

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monia, especially in children; illness ranges from mild to severe airway disease.

### **Paranasal Sinuses**

Air-filled cavities in the bones around the nose that connect with the nasal cavity through small openings. They are lined with mucosa and contribute to mucus production and resonance of the voice.

### **Paraneoplastic Disorder**

A systemic syndrome caused by a malignancy through mechanisms other than direct invasion, metastasis, or metabolic effects of the tumor. Paraneoplastic syndromes result from hormone production, immune-mediated mechanisms, or cytokine release by the tumor, affecting distant organs.

### **Paraneoplastic Neurologic Syndrome**

Neurologic symptoms from immune response to cancer. Examples: Lambert-Eaton, cerebellar degeneration.

### **Paraneoplastic Syndrome**

Symptoms caused by cancer but not by tumor mass or metastasis. Mechanisms: hormone production, immune cross-reaction. Examples: SIADH, Cushing syndrome, Lambert-Eaton myasthenia, hypercalcemia.

### **Paranoia**

A thought process characterized by excessive or irrational suspiciousness and distrust of others, often manifesting as delusions of persecution, reference, or grandeur.

### **Paraphilia**

A condition characterized by intense and persistent sexual interest in atypical objects, situations, or individuals. Examples: exhibitionism, fetishism, frotteurism, pedophilic disorder, sexual masochism, sexual sadism, transvestic disorder, voyeurism, and paraphilia not otherwise specified.

### **Paraphimosis**

Paraphimosis occurs when a retracted foreskin can-

not be returned over the glans, causing painful swelling and possible loss of blood flow; it requires urgent reduction.

### **Parapneumonic Effusion**

Pleural effusion complicating pneumonia. Simple effusions resolve with antibiotics. Complicated effusions (pH < 7.2, glucose < 60 mg/dL) require chest tube drainage.

### **Parapneumonic Pleural Effusion**

Pleural fluid accumulation associated with bacterial pneumonia. It may be uncomplicated or progress to a complicated effusion or empyema, requiring imaging, pleural-fluid analysis, antibiotics, and sometimes drainage.

### **Paraquat**

A highly toxic herbicide. Ingestion can cause injury to the mouth and gastrointestinal tract, kidney failure, and delayed lung injury; severe poisoning has a high risk of death.

### **Paraseptal Emphysema**

A form of emphysema characterized by destruction of alveoli adjacent to the pleura. It typically affects young adults and predisposes to spontaneous pneumothorax due to rupture of subpleural blebs. It may be associated with Marfan syndrome.

### **Parasite**

An organism that lives on or within a host organism, deriving nutrients at the host's expense.

### **Parasitemia**

The presence and measurable burden of parasites in the blood. It is used particularly for malaria and some blood-borne protozoal infections and may correlate with disease severity.

### **Parasitic Infections**

Malaria: Plasmodium (falciparum, vivax, ovale, malariae, knowlesi). Falciparum: cerebral malaria, severe anemia, ARDS, AKI, hypoglycemia. Diagnosis: thick/thin smear, RDT (HRP2 for P. falciparum,



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pLDH for all species, aldolase). Amoebiasis: E.

### **Parasitology**

The branch of microbiology that studies parasites, including protozoa, helminths, and ectoparasites. Parasitic infections are a major global health problem, particularly in tropical and subtropical regions. Protozoan parasites include *Plasmodium* (malaria), *Trypanosoma* (sleeping sickness, Chagas disease), and *Leishmania* (leishmaniasis).

### **Parasympathetic Nervous System**

The craniosacral division of the autonomic nervous system mediating 'rest-and-digest' functions. Preganglionic fibers from cranial nerves III, VII, IX, X, and sacral nerves S2-S4 synapse on ganglia near or within target organs (short postganglionic fibers).

### **Parasympatholytic**

A drug that blocks muscarinic (cholinergic) receptors, inhibiting parasympathetic nervous system activity. Agents: atropine (bradycardia, organophosphate poisoning), ipratropium/tiotropium (COPD/asthma—bronchodilation), scopolamine (motion sickness), oxybutynin/tolterodine (overactive bladder), and glycopyrrolate.

### **Parasympathomimetic**

A drug that mimics or enhances parasympathetic (cholinergic) activity. Direct agonists: muscarinic (pilocarpine—glaucoma, dry mouth) and nicotinic agonists.

### **Parathyroid**

One of the small endocrine glands behind the thyroid that secretes parathyroid hormone and regulates calcium and phosphate balance.

### **Parathyroid Crisis**

Severe hypercalcemia with calcium greater than fourteen milligrams per deciliter causing altered mental status, cardiac arrhythmias, and acute kidney injury. Most commonly occurs in patients with primary hyperparathyroidism precipitated by dehydration, immobility, or thiazide diuretics.

### **Parathyroid Hormone Physiology**

Parathyroid hormone is the primary regulator of calcium homeostasis secreted by the four parathyroid glands in response to low ionized calcium levels detected by the calcium-sensing receptor.

### **Parathyroid Hyperplasia**

Enlargement and increased cellularity of one or more parathyroid glands causing excessive parathyroid hormone secretion and primary hyperparathyroidism. It may occur sporadically or as part of multiple endocrine neoplasia.

### **Parathyroid Surgery**

Operations on the parathyroid glands, usually performed for selected cases of primary or secondary hyperparathyroidism. The decision depends on symptoms, calcium levels, kidney involvement, bone disease, overall health, and current clinical guidance.

### **Parathyroidectomy**

Surgical removal of parathyroid glands for refractory secondary hyperparathyroidism unresponsive to medical therapy. Indicated when calcium-phosphorus product persistently elevated despite maximal medical management, symptomatic bone disease, or calciphylaxis. Subtotal or total parathyroidectomy with autotransplantation.

### **Parenteral Nutrition**

Intravenous nutrition bypassing GI tract. Total parenteral nutrition (TPN) provides complete nutrition. Indications: bowel failure, short bowel syndrome, prolonged NPO, malabsorption. Risks: infection, liver dysfunction, metabolic complications, line complications.

### **Parietal Lobe**

The cerebral lobe posterior to the central sulcus and above the lateral sulcus, containing the primary somatosensory cortex (postcentral gyrus, Brodmann 3,1,2) processing touch, pain, temperature, and proprioception, plus the somatosensory association cortex.

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## Parinaud Syndrome

A disorder caused by dysfunction of the dorsal midbrain, characterized by impaired upward gaze, abnormal pupil responses, and convergence-retraction eye movements. Causes include tumors, stroke, multiple sclerosis, and hydrocephalus.

## Parkinson Disease

A progressive neurodegenerative disorder characterized by the loss of dopaminergic neurons in the substantia nigra pars compacta of the midbrain, leading to reduced dopamine levels in the striatum and the cardinal motor features of bradykinesia, resting tremor, rigidity, and postural instability.

## Parkinson's Disease

A progressive neurodegenerative disorder caused by selective loss of dopaminergic neurons in the substantia nigra pars compacta, leading to dopamine depletion in the striatum. The pathological hallmark is the presence of Lewy bodies, intracellular inclusions composed of aggregated alpha-synuclein protein, within surviving neurons.

### Synonyms:

Parkinsons Disease (Parkinson's Disease)

## Parkinsonism

A clinical syndrome characterized by bradykinesia, rigidity, tremor (resting, pill-rolling), and postural instability. Idiopathic Parkinson disease: most common cause, responds well to levodopa.

## Paronychia

Paronychia is infection or inflammation of tissue around a fingernail or toenail, producing pain, redness, swelling, and sometimes a localized abscess. Streptococcus), presenting as painful, erythematous, swollen nail fold with possible abscess. Treatment includes warm compresses, antibiotics, and incision and drainage if abscessed.

## Parotid Gland

The largest of the three major salivary glands, located in the preauricular region, extending from the zygomatic arch superiorly to the angle of the mandible inferiorly. The parotid gland is encased in

the parotid fascia (investing layer of deep cervical fascia).

## Paroxysmal Nocturnal Dyspnea

Episodes of breathlessness that awaken a person from sleep after a period of lying down. It can occur with heart failure or other cardiopulmonary conditions and differs from orthopnea, which begins soon after lying down.

## Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria

A rare, acquired clonal disorder of hematopoietic stem cells characterized by complement-mediated intravascular hemolysis, thrombosis (particularly in unusual sites such as hepatic, portal, and cerebral veins), and bone marrow failure.

## Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia

Sudden-onset and sudden-termination episodes of rapid regular tachycardia arising above the ventricles, usually involving an atrioventricular re-entry or nodal re-entry circuit. Palpitations, dizziness, chest discomfort, or syncope may occur.

## Partial Agonist

A partial agonist is a drug that binds to a receptor and produces a biological response that is less than the maximum possible response, even when all receptors are occupied. Partial agonists have affinity for the receptor but lower intrinsic activity compared to full agonists, producing a submaximal response regardless of dose.

## Partial Denture

Removable prosthesis replacing some teeth. Metal framework or acrylic. Requires remaining teeth for support.

## Partial Response

Significant tumor reduction but not complete.

## Partial Thromboplastin Time

A coagulation test measuring the intrinsic and common pathways (factors XII, XI, IX, VIII, X, V, II, fibrinogen), used to monitor unfractionated heparin

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and detect factor deficiencies.

### **Partial Volume Artifact**

CT artifact from voxel containing multiple tissues. Reduced by thinner slices.

### **Partial-Volume Effect**

Underestimation or distortion of measured activity in small or low-contrast structures because the object size approaches the scanner's spatial resolution. It affects quantitative PET and SPECT and may require recovery or correction methods.

### **Particle (Vascular)**

An embolic particle used to occlude selected vessels under image guidance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Particulate Matter**

Small solid or liquid particles suspended in air. Fine particles can penetrate the lungs and increase cardiovascular and respiratory risk.

### **Partograph (Partogram)**

A graphic record of cervical change, fetal descent, contractions, and maternal or fetal observations during labor. It can support communication and recognition of abnormal progress, but findings must be interpreted with current labor guidance and the overall clinical situation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Partogram

### **Parturition (Childbirth)**

The process of giving birth, encompassing three stages: (1) First stage: from the onset of regular uterine contractions (cervical effacement and dilation) to full dilation (10 cm). Latent phase—slow dilation (0–4 cm) over hours, variable duration. Active phase—more rapid dilation (4–10 cm), typically 1–1.5 cm/hour in nulliparous women.

#### **Synonyms:**

Childbirth

### **Parvovirus B19**

Human parvovirus B19: a small DNA virus causing erythema infectiosum ('fifth disease') in children, transmitted by respiratory droplets.

### **Parvovirus B19 Infection**

A viral infection that may cause slapped-cheek rash, joint symptoms, or temporary suppression of red-cell production.

### **Pasteurella Multocida**

A bacterium commonly carried by animals that can cause wound infections after bites or scratches and, less often, respiratory or bloodstream infection.

### **Pasteurization**

A heat treatment reducing microbial load in liquids by heating below boiling point to inactivate vegetative pathogens and spoilage organisms while preserving quality.

### **Patau Syndrome**

Trisomy 13, affecting 1 in 10,000-20,000 live births. Features: holoprosencephaly (most characteristic, incomplete forebrain division), microcephaly, microphthalmia or anophthalmia, cleft lip and palate, polydactyly (postaxial), clenched fists with overlapping fingers, and congenital heart defects (VSD, PDA, dextrocardia, 80%).

### **Patch**

A flat, circumscribed area of altered skin color larger than approximately 1 cm. It is the larger counterpart of a macule and may be caused by pigmentary, vascular, inflammatory, or neoplastic disease.

### **Patch (Vascular)**

A piece of biological or synthetic material sewn onto a blood vessel to widen or repair it.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Patch Graft**

Vascular graft for patch angioplasty. Bovine pericardium, PTFE.

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## Patch Testing

Patch testing identifies allergens causing allergic contact dermatitis. The standard series includes 35 allergens. Additional custom trays include occupational and personal allergens. Patches are applied to the upper back for 48 hours and removed. Reading at 48 hours (initial) and 72 to 96 hours (delayed) identifies positive reactions.

## Patella

The largest sesamoid bone, embedded in the quadriceps tendon. It articulates with the femoral trochlea to form the patellofemoral joint and improves the mechanical efficiency of knee extension. It is triangular and covered by thick articular cartilage.

## Patella (Kneecap)

The largest sesamoid bone in the human body, embedded within the quadriceps tendon at the front of the knee. It improves the mechanical efficiency of knee extension, protects the front of the joint, and distributes forces across the femoral trochlea.

**Synonyms:**  
Kneecap

## Patellofemoral Instability

A tendency of the patella to move abnormally or dislocate from the femoral trochlea. Risk factors include abnormal trochlear shape, a high-riding patella, ligament insufficiency, altered limb alignment, and previous dislocation.

## Patellofemoral Pain Syndrome

Anterior knee pain related to the patellofemoral joint, common in adolescents and young adults (especially runners). Etiology: multifactorial (malalignment, quadriceps imbalance, overuse, tight lateral structures, weak VMO, and patellar instability).

**Synonyms:**  
Runner's Knee

## Patent Ductus Arteriosus

A congenital heart defect characterized by persistent patency of the ductus arteriosus, a vessel connecting the pulmonary artery to the proximal descending

aorta, which normally closes within the first few days of life. The resulting left-to-right shunt leads to pulmonary overcirculation and left heart volume overload.

## Patent Foramen Ovale

A persistent flap-like opening between the atria that normally permits fetal blood flow and usually closes after birth. It is often an incidental finding but may allow a clot to pass from the venous to the arterial circulation in selected circumstances.

## Paternal Uniparental Disomy 14 (UDP 14 Pat) Thoracic Dysplasia

A rare genetic condition resulting from inheritance of both copies of chromosome 14 from the father, leading to dysregulated expression of imprinted genes on chromosome 14. It presents with severe thoracic hypoplasia, pulmonary hypoplasia, and characteristic facial features. It is a lethal condition in most cases.

**Synonyms:**  
UDP 14 pat

## Paternity Testing

The use of genetic markers to establish or exclude a biological parent-child relationship, the reference method being short tandem repeat DNA profiling of the child, alleged father, and mother. Modern STR analysis commonly yields paternity probability exceeding 99.99 percent for true fathers.

## Pathogen

A tiny organism such as a virus, bacterium, or parasite that can invade the body and produce disease.

## Pathogenesis

Mechanism of disease development. Steps: initiation, promotion, progression.

## Pathogenic Variant

A genetic variant with sufficient validated evidence to be interpreted as causing or contributing to disease. Classification uses standardized evidence from population data, segregation, functional studies, computational analysis, and phenotype correlation.

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## **Pathogenicity**

The capacity of a microorganism to cause disease in a susceptible host. Pathogenicity is a qualitative property, whereas virulence describes the relative degree of disease-causing capacity among strains or organisms.

## **Pathologic Fracture**

A fracture occurring through bone weakened by an underlying disease such as metastasis, myeloma, infection, benign tumor, or metabolic bone disorder. Evaluation includes characterization of the lesion and treatment of both the fracture and its cause.

## **Pathologic Hypertrophy**

The enlargement of an organ resulting from an increase in the size of its constituent cells without an increase in cell number, typically occurring as a response to chronically increased workload or hormonal stimulation.

## **Pathology**

Study of disease. Includes general pathology (cell injury, inflammation, neoplasia) and systemic pathology (organ-specific diseases).

## **Pathology Artifact**

A distortion, alteration, or contaminant introduced during specimen collection, fixation, processing, sectioning, staining, or imaging rather than representing true disease. Artifacts must be recognized to avoid diagnostic error.

## **Patient**

Person receiving medical care. Also: patient zero (initial case), patient safety.

## **Patient Advocacy**

Acting on behalf of a patient to ensure that the patient's needs, rights, and preferences are addressed in healthcare.

## **Patient Communication**

The exchange of information and understanding between a patient, caregivers, and healthcare pro-

fessionals during care.

## **Patient Education**

The process of explaining a health condition, treatment, medicines, exercises, equipment, warning signs, and prevention strategies in a way the patient can understand and use.

## **Patient Positioning**

Placing and supporting a patient in a position that permits safe care, accurate examination or imaging, and adequate comfort.

## **Patient Preparation**

The instructions and assessments completed before a test or procedure, such as fasting, medicine review, hydration, consent, or skin preparation when required.

## **Patient Safety**

Prevention of harm from healthcare. Examples: medication errors, healthcare-associated infections, surgical errors. Strategies: checklists, hand hygiene, barcoding.

## **Patient-Centered Care**

Care respecting patient preferences, needs, values. Examples: shared decision-making, communication, coordination.

## **Patient-Centered Outcome**

An outcome that reflects what matters to the patient, including symptoms, function, quality of life, treatment burden, and ability to achieve personal goals, rather than relying only on laboratory or imaging measures.

## **Patient-Controlled Analgesia**

A method in which a patient self-administers prescribed doses of analgesic medication using a programmable pump with preset safety limits. The medication, dose, and lockout interval are individualized according to the patient's condition and monitoring needs.



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### Patient-Reported Outcome Measure

A validated questionnaire completed directly by a patient to assess symptoms, function, health status, or quality of life without clinician interpretation of the response.

### Patlak Plot

Linear graphical method for quantitative PET.

### Pattern Recognition Receptors

PRRs recognize PAMPs (pathogen) and DAMPs (damage). TLRs: TLR1/2 (lipoproteins), TLR2/6 (lipoteichoic acid), TLR3 (dsRNA), TLR4 (LPS, MD-2, CD14), TLR5 (flagellin), TLR7/8 (ss-RNA), TLR9 (CpG DNA). Cytosolic: RIG-I/MDA5 (RNA), cGAS (DNA -> cGAMP -> STING -> IFN), NOD1/2 (peptidoglycan).

### PCL Injuries

Posterior cruciate ligament (PCL) tears: dashboard injury (posterior tibial force), hyperflexion. Clinical: posterior drawer (most sensitive), quadriceps active test, posterior sag sign. Grade I (1-5mm), II (6-10mm), III (>10mm). Isolated PCL: nonoperative (brace, rehab) for Grade I/II; surgical for Grade III or combined.

### PCOS

Common endocrine disorder affecting six to twelve percent of reproductive-aged women characterized by hyperandrogenism, ovulatory dysfunction, and polycystic ovarian morphology on ultrasound. See Polycystic Ovary Syndrome.

### PCR (Polymerase Chain Reaction)

Technique amplifying specific DNA sequences exponentially. Components: template DNA, primers, DNA polymerase (Taq), nucleotides, buffer. Cycles: denaturation, annealing, extension. Applications: diagnostics, forensics, research.

#### Synonyms:

Polymerase Chain Reaction

### PE Anticoagulation

Anticoagulant treatment for pulmonary embolism

to prevent clot extension and recurrence. Options include direct oral anticoagulants, heparins, and vitamin K antagonists; the choice and duration depend on bleeding risk, pregnancy, kidney function, cancer, provoking factors, and other clinical features.

### Peak Expiratory Flow Rate

The maximum flow rate achieved during a forced expiratory manoeuvre after maximal inspiration, measured in litres per minute (L/min) using a peak flow meter. PEFR reflects the degree of airflow obstruction and is effort-dependent.

### Pearly Penile Papules

Small, benign, dome-shaped papules arranged circumferentially around the glans penis, representing normal anatomical variants requiring no treatment.

### Pectoralis Major Muscle

Thick fan-shaped chest muscle with clavicular and sternocostal heads, inserting on the lateral intertubercular groove lip. Innervated by medial/lateral pectoral nerves (C5-T1). Clavicular head flexes; sternocostal head extends from flexion. Adducts and medially rotates powerfully.

### Pectoralis Minor Muscle

Thin triangular muscle deep to pectoralis major, from ribs 3-5 to the coracoid process. Innervated by medial pectoral nerve (C8-T1). Draws scapula anteriorly/inferiorly, stabilizing it against the thorax. Assists forced inspiration. Tightness contributes to rounded shoulder posture and thoracic outlet syndrome.

### Pectus Carinatum

A congenital chest wall deformity characterized by anterior protrusion of the sternum (pigeon chest), caused by excessive growth of the costal cartilages pushing the sternum forward. Less common than pectus excavatum. Associated with congenital heart disease, Marfan syndrome, Noonan syndrome, and homocystinuria.



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## **Pectus Excavatum**

The most common congenital chest wall deformity, characterized by depression of the sternum (funnel chest), caused by excessive growth of the costal cartilages that push the sternum inward. Typically sporadic, but associated with Marfan syndrome, Ehlers-Danlos syndrome, Noonan syndrome, and Poland syndrome.

### **Synonyms:**

Sunken Chest

## **Pediatric Anesthesia**

Pediatric anesthesia requires age-appropriate dosing, equipment, and techniques. Children have higher metabolic rates, increased oxygen consumption, smaller functional residual capacity, and higher risk of desaturation. Airway anatomy differs (larger tongue, more anterior larynx, narrower subglottic area).

## **Pediatric Appendicitis**

Acute inflammation of the vermiform appendix, usually caused by luminal obstruction. Children may have evolving periumbilical-to-right-lower-quadrant pain, anorexia, vomiting, fever, and guarding, but presentation can be atypical in young children; timely surgical and antimicrobial assessment reduces perforation risk.

## **Pediatric Cancer**

Cancer occurring in infants, children, or adolescents. Common types include leukemia, brain tumors, lymphoma, neuroblastoma, and Wilms tumor; prognosis varies by type and stage.

## **Pediatric Dentistry**

Specialty of dental care for children. Manages primary dentition, growth, behavior. Preventive focus. Special needs adaptation.

## **Pediatric Dermatology**

The medical specialty concerned with skin, hair, and nail disorders in infants, children, and adolescents. It includes congenital lesions, inflammatory diseases, infections, vascular lesions, and tumors.

## **Pediatric Dermatology Conditions**

Distinct from adult dermatology. Birthmarks include vascular (hemangiomas, port-wine stains) and pigmented (café-au-lait, congenital nevi, Mongolian spots). Infantile hemangiomas proliferate in first months then involute. Congenital melanocytic nevi carry melanoma risk proportional to size.

## **Pediatric Diabetic Ketoacidosis**

A life-threatening complication of type 1 diabetes characterized by hyperglycemia, metabolic acidosis, and ketosis. Presents with polyuria, polydipsia, vomiting, abdominal pain, Kussmaul respirations, and fruity breath odor.

## **Pediatric Eczema**

Atopic dermatitis in children commonly begins in infancy with facial and extensor involvement; flexural disease predominates in older children. Pruritus, xerosis, sleep disturbance, and scratching are characteristic.

## **Pediatric Fever**

An elevated body temperature in a child, usually caused by infection but sometimes by inflammation, medicines, or environmental heat. Evaluation depends on age, appearance, duration, and associated findings.

## **Pediatric Health**

Pediatric health encompasses the physical, cognitive, emotional, and social development of children from infancy through adolescence, with emphasis on preventive care, developmental surveillance, and age-appropriate management of acute and chronic conditions.

## **Pediatric Meningitis**

Inflammation of the meninges in children, bacterial forms being the most dangerous. Presents with fever, headache, neck stiffness, photophobia, altered mental status, and petechial rash (meningococcal). Infants may present with irritability, poor feeding, bulging fontanelle, and high-pitched cry.

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## **Pediatric Nuclear Medicine**

Special considerations for children: lower doses, sedation often needed, distraction techniques. Dose reduction: weight-based activity, optimized protocols.

## **Pediatric Rehabilitation**

Rehabilitation for children with congenital or acquired disabilities. Developmental considerations, family-centered care, school collaboration.

## **Pediatric Shock**

Inadequate tissue oxygen delivery or utilization in a child, most often caused by hypovolemia, distributive disease, cardiogenic dysfunction, or obstruction. Children may maintain blood pressure until late; tachycardia, abnormal perfusion, altered mental status, and oliguria are important early warning signs.

## **Pediatric Skin Tumors**

Pediatric skin tumors differ from adult tumors. Infantile hemangioma is the most common benign tumor of infancy. Congenital melanocytic nevus carries risk of melanoma (larger nevi have higher risk). Juvenile xanthogranuloma is a benign histiocytic lesion. Pyogenic granuloma is a common vascular lesion.

## **Pediatric Toxicology**

Poisoning in children. Common: iron, medications, household cleaners, plants. Prevention: child-proof containers, education.

## **Pediatrician**

A medical doctor who specializes in the health and medical care of children from birth through adolescence (typically up to age 16-18).

## **Pediatrics**

The branch of medicine concerned with the health and medical care of infants, children, and adolescents from birth to age 18 (or up to age 16 in the UK).

## **Pediculosis Capitis**

Infestation of the scalp by head lice, causing itching and attached eggs or lice in the hair.

## **Pediculus Humanus Capitis**

A blood-sucking parasite commonly known as the louse (plural, lice) that can cause an itchy scalp; infestations are highly contagious and especially common in school-age children.

## **Pedophilic Disorder**

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent, intense sexual fantasies, urges, or behaviors toward pre-pubescent children, generally beginning in adolescence or adulthood. Clinical diagnosis requires the criteria to cause significant distress or impairment, or to be acted upon, and requires the person to meet established age-difference criteria.

## **PEG Tube**

A feeding tube placed through the abdominal wall into the stomach using endoscopic guidance.

## **Percutaneous Endoscopic Gastrostomy**

Endoscopic placement of a feeding tube through the abdominal wall directly into the stomach. Indications: long-term enteral feeding (>4 weeks) for dysphagia (stroke, ALS, dementia, head/neck cancer) and malnutrition.

## **Pelvic Binder**

A circumferential device applied around the pelvis to reduce motion and hemorrhage from suspected unstable pelvic-ring injury. It should be centered over the greater trochanters and used with definitive imaging and hemorrhage-control management.

## **Pelvic Cavity**

The lower abdominal cavity enclosed by the pelvis, containing the urinary bladder, internal reproductive organs, and rectum.

## **Pelvic Congestion Syndrome**

Chronic pelvic pain associated with enlarged or inefficient pelvic veins, often worsening with prolonged

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standing, before menstruation, or after intercourse. Diagnosis requires evaluation for other causes of pelvic pain and may involve pelvic imaging; treatment is individualized by gynecology or vascular specialists.

### **Pelvic Floor Dysfunction**

Weakness, overactivity, poor coordination, or injury of the muscles and connective tissues supporting the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs. Symptoms may include urinary or fecal problems, pelvic pain, constipation, pain with sex, or pelvic organ prolapse; assessment may involve pelvic-health clinicians.

### **Pelvic Floor Health And Disorders**

The pelvic floor is a musculofascial sling (levator ani, coccygeus, and surrounding fascia) spanning the pelvic outlet, supporting the pelvic organs (bladder, uterus, rectum), maintaining continence, and facilitating urination, defecation, and sexual function.

### **Pelvic Inflammatory Disease**

Infection and inflammation of the upper female genital tract (uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries, and peritoneum), most commonly caused by sexually transmitted infections (*Chlamydia trachomatis*, *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*). Presents with lower abdominal pain, cervical motion tenderness, adnexal tenderness, and fever.

### **Pelvic Inlet**

The superior opening of the true pelvis, bounded by the sacral promontory posteriorly, the arcuate lines of the ilia laterally, and the symphysis pubis anteriorly. Its anteroposterior diameter (true conjugate) normally measures at least 11 cm. The transverse diameter is typically 13 cm.

### **Pelvic Organ Prolapse**

POP: descent of the pelvic organs through the vagina due to pelvic floor weakness. Types: cystocele (anterior—bladder), rectocele (posterior—rectum), uterine prolapse (apical), enterocele, and vault prolapse (post-hysterectomy).

### **Pelvic Outlet**

The inferior opening of the true pelvis, bounded by the pubic symphysis, ischial tuberosities, sacrotuberous ligaments, and coccyx. Normal anteroposterior diameter is 11-13 cm (from the lower border of the pubic symphysis to the tip of the coccyx), and the transverse diameter (between the ischial tuberosities) is approximately 10-11 cm.

### **Pelvic Pain During Early Pregnancy**

Pain in the pelvis or lower abdomen during early pregnancy, caused by normal uterine changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, ovarian disease, infection, or other conditions. Severe or one-sided pain, shoulder pain, fainting, fever, or vaginal bleeding requires emergency assessment.

### **Pelvic Pain**

Pain localized to the lower abdomen, pelvis, or perineum, lasting <3 months (acute) or >3–6 months (chronic), and can arise from gynecologic, urologic, gastrointestinal, musculoskeletal, or psychologic causes.

### **Pelvic Spleen**

An ectopic or wandering spleen that has descended into the pelvic cavity, resulting from laxity or absence of the normal ligamentous attachments that fix the spleen in the left upper quadrant. It may present as a palpable pelvic mass, with risk of torsion, infarction, or rupture. Diagnosis is by CT or ultrasound.

### **Pemberton Sign**

Facial flushing, cyanosis, or breathing difficulty induced by raising both arms, suggesting obstruction at the thoracic inlet, often from a large retrosternal goiter.

### **Pemberton's Sign**

A clinical sign elicited by asking the patient to raise both arms above the head for one minute, causing facial plethora, cyanosis, and distended neck veins in patients with a substernal goiter or mediastinal mass compressing the thoracic inlet.

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## Pemphigoid Gestationis

An autoimmune blistering disease of pregnancy characterised by intensely pruritic urticarial plaques and tense vesicles or bullae, typically arising in the second or third trimester around the umbilicus and spreading to the trunk and extremities.

## Pemphigus Vulgaris

An autoimmune intraepidermal blistering disease caused by IgG antibodies against desmoglein 1 and 3. It presents with flaccid blisters that rupture easily, leaving painful erosions of skin and mucous membranes. Nikolsky sign is positive (lateral pressure causes epidermal sloughing).

## Penetrance

Proportion of individuals with a particular genotype who express the expected phenotype. Complete penetrance: all with genotype show phenotype. Incomplete penetrance: some with genotype do not show phenotype.

## Penetrating Abdominal Trauma

Injury to the abdomen caused by a projectile, sharp object, or other penetrating force. It may damage abdominal organs or blood vessels and requires urgent assessment for internal bleeding or organ injury; management depends on the mechanism, examination, stability, and imaging findings.

## Penile Adhesions

Abnormal attachment of penile skin to the glans, often after circumcision or during childhood. They may cause irritation or conceal part of the glans and are assessed and treated according to severity.

## Penile Discharge

Fluid leaving the urethral opening that is not normal urine or semen. It may result from urethritis, including sexually transmitted infection, and requires clinical assessment and appropriate testing.

## Penile Edema

Swelling of the penis caused by inflammation, infection, trauma, allergic reaction, impaired lymphatic drainage, or a constricting ring or retracted foreskin.

Sudden painful swelling with an irreducible foreskin is an emergency.

## Penile Cancer

Rare malignancy, mostly squamous cell carcinoma. Risk factors: HPV, phimosis, poor hygiene, smoking. Presentation: penile lesion, ulcer, mass. Treatment: surgery (partial/total penectomy), radiation, chemotherapy.

## Penile Fracture

Rupture of tunica albuginea during erection. "Pop" sound, immediate detumescence, swelling, ecchymosis. Surgical emergency.

## Penile Implant

A surgically implanted device used to produce penile rigidity in selected people with erectile dysfunction that has not responded to other treatments.

## Penile Prosthesis

Inflatable or malleative device for erectile dysfunction. Types: two-piece, three-piece (reservoir, pump, cylinders). Surgical implantation. Complications: infection, erosion, mechanical failure, dissatisfaction.

## Penile Torsion

Rotation of the penis around its longitudinal axis, usually a congenital condition in which the glans or urethral opening is rotated. Symptomatic or marked torsion may require urologic evaluation and surgical correction.

## Penile Hygiene

Routine cleaning and drying of the penis and foreskin, with gentle retraction only when it moves freely and replacement afterward. Good hygiene helps reduce irritation and infection without harsh soaps or forceful retraction.

## Pentad Of TTP

Classic clinical pentad of Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura: (1) Thrombocytopenia, (2) Microangiopathic Hemolytic Anemia (schistocytes),

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(3) Neurological symptoms, (4) Renal insufficiency, and (5) Fever. See Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (TTP).

### **Pentavalent Vaccine**

A WHO-prequalified five-in-one combination vaccine containing Diphtheria toxoid, Tetanus toxoid, whole-cell Pertussis antigen, Hepatitis B (HBsAg), and Haemophilus influenzae type b (Hib) conjugate, administered as a single intramuscular injection.

### **Pentose Phosphate Pathway**

A cytoplasmic glucose oxidation pathway running parallel to glycolysis, primarily in the liver, adipose tissue, adrenal cortex, and red blood cells. It has two phases: the oxidative phase (producing NADPH and ribose-5-phosphate) and the non-oxidative phase (interconverting sugar phosphates).

### **Peptic Ulcer Bleeding**

Haemorrhage caused by erosion of an artery or other blood vessel beneath a gastric or duodenal peptic ulcer. It is a common cause of upper gastrointestinal bleeding and may present with haematemesis, coffee-ground vomiting, melaena, or haemodynamic instability.

### **Peptic Ulcer Disease**

Condition characterized by ulceration of the gastrointestinal mucosa extending through the muscularis mucosae into the submucosa or deeper layers, occurring most commonly in the duodenal bulb and gastric antrum.

### **Peptide Bond**

A covalent amide bond formed between the carboxyl group of one amino acid and the amino group of another, releasing water. Peptide bonds link amino acids into polypeptide chains and have partial double-bond character that restricts rotation.

### **Percussion Note**

The sound produced by percussing the chest wall. Normal lung produces a resonant note. Dullness suggests consolidation or fluid. Hyperresonance suggests pneumothorax or emphysema. Stony dullness

suggests pleural effusion.

### **Percutaneous Biopsy**

Removal of tissue through the skin using a needle or other instrument, often guided by ultrasound, CT, or another imaging method.

### **Percutaneous Coronary Intervention**

A catheter-based procedure to open blocked coronary arteries, typically involving balloon angioplasty and stent placement. Indications include acute STEMI (primary PCI), NSTEMI (early invasive strategy), and stable CAD with significant stenosis. Drug-eluting stents have reduced restenosis rates compared to bare-metal stents.

### **Percutaneous Drainage**

Placement of a needle or catheter through the skin to drain a fluid collection or obstructed body space, often with imaging guidance.

### **Percutaneous Nephrolithotomy**

Minimally invasive surgical procedure for removing large, complex, or staghorn renal calculi. Access: a needle track is established under fluoroscopic or ultrasound guidance from the flank through the renal parenchyma into the target renal calyx, dilated to allow passage of a nephroscope and working sheath.

### **Percutaneous Transluminal Angioplasty**

Balloon dilation of arterial stenosis. Often combined with stenting.

### **Percutaneous Umbilical Blood Sampling**

An invasive procedure for fetal blood sampling from the umbilical vein under ultrasound guidance, typically performed after 18-20 weeks.

### **Perforation Of A Viscus**

Full-thickness breach of the wall of a hollow abdominal organ, most commonly the stomach, duodenum, or colon, resulting in leakage of luminal contents into the peritoneal cavity. Causes include peptic ulcer disease, diverticulitis, appendicitis, inflammatory bowel disease, ischemia, and trauma.



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### Performance Status

A standardized measure of a patient's functional ability and activity level, commonly recorded with ECOG or Karnofsky scales. It helps estimate prognosis, determine treatment eligibility, and quantify change during cancer care.

### Perfusion Imaging

Imaging tissue blood flow. CT perfusion, MR perfusion, PET perfusion. Used for stroke, tumor characterization.

### Perfusion PET

Tracers: Rb-82, N-13 ammonia, O-15 water. Measure blood flow.

### Periapical Abscess

An acute or chronic localized collection of pus at the apex of a tooth's root, arising from pulpal infection and necrosis (usually due to untreated dental caries or trauma).

### Periapical Granuloma

A chronic inflammatory lesion at the apex of a tooth, usually resulting from pulpal necrosis and persistent apical infection. It may be asymptomatic and is diagnosed through clinical, radiographic, and sometimes histopathologic assessment.

### Pericardial Cavity

The narrow, fluid-filled space between the layers of the pericardium surrounding the heart.

### Pericardial Effusion Etiology

Causes include infection, malignancy, kidney failure, hypothyroidism, autoimmune disease, inflammation after myocardial injury or cardiac surgery, radiation, trauma, and some medications. The likely cause varies with geography, age, medical history, and immune status.

### Pericardial Knock

A high-pitched, early diastolic sound caused by sudden cessation of ventricular filling in constrictive pericarditis. It is heard at the left sternal border

and may be confused with an S3 or opening snap. The knock is typically louder with inspiration and is a characteristic finding in constrictive pericarditis.

### Pericardial Metastases

Cancer deposits in the pericardium, which may cause inflammation or accumulation of fluid around the heart.

### Pericardial Tamponade

Fluid accumulation in pericardial space compromising cardiac filling. Beck triad: hypotension, jugular venous distension, muffled heart sounds. Electrical alternans on ECG. Diagnosis: echocardiography. Treatment: emergent pericardiocentesis, pericardial window.

### Pericardiocentesis

Pericardiocentesis is needle or catheter drainage of fluid from the pericardial sac, usually to relieve cardiac tamponade or diagnose an effusion; bleeding, arrhythmia, coronary injury, and pneumothorax are possible complications. Cardiac tamponade or diagnostically for pericardial effusion. The subxiphoid approach is most commonly used, with the needle directed toward the left shoulder under echocardiographic guidance.

### Perichondritis Of The Ear

Infection or inflammation of the auricular perichondrium, often after trauma, piercing, or surgery. *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* is an important cause; delayed treatment can produce cartilage necrosis and permanent deformity.

### Pericoronitis

Inflammation of the soft tissue around the crown of a partially erupted tooth, most often a mandibular third molar. Food retention and bacterial accumulation may cause pain, swelling, trismus, fever, or spread into deeper spaces.

### Periductal Mastitis

Inflammation around the major subareolar ducts, often associated with smoking, causing a painful periareolar mass, discharge, or recurrent breast ab-



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ccess.

### **Perilymphatic Fistula**

Abnormal communication between the inner ear fluid spaces and the middle ear or mastoid, often after trauma, barotrauma, or surgery. It may cause episodic vertigo, hearing loss, tinnitus, or pressure-induced symptoms and requires specialist evaluation.

### **Perimenopause**

The transition time in a woman's life that begins when ovaries produce less estrogen and menstruation becomes less frequent, and ends when the ovaries no longer produce eggs and menstruation stops.

### **Perinatal Psychiatry**

The subspecialty focused on psychiatric disorders during pregnancy and the postpartum period. Common conditions include perinatal depression, perinatal anxiety, perinatal OCD, and postpartum psychosis. Medication selection must balance maternal mental health with fetal or neonatal exposure risks.

### **Perineal Laceration**

Tearing of the perineal tissues during vaginal delivery. The injury is graded by depth: it may involve skin, perineal muscle, the anal sphincter, or the rectal mucosa.

### **Perineal Laceration Classification**

Obstetric perineal tears are graded by depth: first degree involves skin, second degree involves perineal muscle, third degree involves the anal sphincter complex, and fourth degree extends through the rectal mucosa. Accurate examination and repair reduce long-term pelvic-floor and continence complications.

### **Perineal Protection**

Techniques used during the second stage to minimize perineal trauma (lacerations, episiotomy). Manual protection: the attendant's hand applies gentle pressure to the fetal head to control the speed of delivery (not too fast), supporting the perineum and flexing the fetal head.

### **Perineal Tear**

Laceration of the perineum during vaginal delivery, classified by degree: first degree (skin only), second degree (perineal muscles), third degree (sphincter complex involvement), and fourth degree (rectal mucosa). Most deliveries involve first or second degree tears. Third and fourth degree tears risk fecal incontinence.

### **Periodontal Abscess**

A localized accumulation of pus within periodontal tissues, commonly associated with a periodontal pocket, foreign material, or impaired drainage. It may cause pain, swelling, suppuration, tooth mobility, and systemic symptoms and requires urgent dental assessment.

### **Periodontal Flap Surgery**

Surgical access for deep debridement. Flap reflected, calculus removed, bone contoured, flap repositioned.

### **Periodontal Ligament**

Connective tissue attaching tooth to bone. Contains collagen fibers, cells, blood vessels, nerves. Provides proprioception, shock absorption. Expanded in bruxism.

### **Periodontal Pocket**

A pathologically deepened gingival sulcus caused by apical migration of the junctional epithelium and loss of periodontal attachment. Pocket depth and clinical attachment level are measured with a periodontal probe and interpreted with bleeding, inflammation, and radiographic bone loss.

### **Periodontal Probing**

Measurement of the depth of the gingival sulcus/pocket using a periodontal probe with millimeter markings. Normal: 1–3 mm. Periodontal pockets:  $\geq 4$  mm (indicates attachment loss and periodontitis). Full-mouth probing at 6 sites per tooth: mesio-buccal, mid-buccal, disto-buccal, mesio-lingual, mid-lingual, disto-lingual.

### **Perioperative Antibiotic Prophylaxis**

Administration of an appropriate antimicrobial

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within a defined interval before incision to reduce infection risk for selected procedures. Choice, timing, redosing, and discontinuation depend on procedure, organisms, patient factors, and local guidance.

### **Perioral Dermatitis**

A papulopustular eruption around the mouth, sparing the vermilion border. It is more common in young women and associated with topical corticosteroid use. Other triggers include fluoridated toothpaste, cosmetics, and inhaler steroids.

### **Peripancreatic Malignancy**

Neoplastic process involving tissues surrounding the pancreas, including primary pancreatic adenocarcinoma with peripancreatic extension and metastatic disease from adjacent or distant organs. Often presents at an advanced stage with abdominal pain, weight loss, obstructive jaundice, and new-onset diabetes.

### **Peripartum Cardiomyopathy**

A form of dilated cardiomyopathy occurring in the last month of pregnancy or within 5 months postpartum, with no other identifiable cause. Risk factors include advanced maternal age, multiple gestations, preeclampsia, and African American race. Presents with heart failure symptoms.

### **Peripartum Cardiomyopathy Prognosis**

Recovery of ventricular function varies widely. Prognosis is influenced by the initial ejection fraction, ventricular size, symptoms, treatment, complications, and follow-up; persistent dysfunction requires ongoing cardiac care.

### **Peripheral**

Peripheral means away from the center or central nervous system; in clinical use it may describe nerves, vessels, lesions, circulation, or symptoms outside the brain, spinal cord, or central structures.

### **Peripheral Arterial Disease**

Atherosclerotic narrowing of arteries supplying limbs. Symptoms: intermittent claudication (pain with walking, relieved by rest), critical limb ischemia

(rest pain, ulcers, gangrene). Diagnosis: ABI <0.9, Doppler, angiography. Treatment: risk factor modification, exercise, cilostazol, revascularization for severe disease.

### **Peripheral Artery Disease**

Narrowing of arteries supplying the limbs, usually caused by atherosclerosis. It may cause exertional leg pain relieved by rest, reduced pulses, nonhealing wounds, or critical limb ischemia. Also called peripheral arterial disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

peripheral arterial disease.

### **Peripheral Blood Smear**

Microscopic examination of a stained blood smear (Wright-Giemsa stain).

### **Peripheral Blood Stem Cells**

Hematopoietic stem cells collected from circulating blood, usually after mobilization from the bone marrow; they can be used for autologous or allogeneic stem-cell transplantation.

### **Peripheral Edema**

Swelling due to accumulation of fluid in the interstitial space of the limbs, most commonly the lower extremities.

### **Peripheral Oedema**

Alternate spelling of Peripheral Edema; swelling caused by excess interstitial fluid, usually in the limbs.

### **Peripheral Nerve Blocks**

Peripheral nerve blocks provide targeted anesthesia and analgesia for specific surgical sites. Ultrasound-guided blocks improve success rates and reduce complications.

### **Peripheral Nerve Injuries**

Damage to nerves outside the brain and spinal cord caused by trauma, compression, stretching, disease, or toxins. It may cause pain, numbness, weakness, or loss of function; recovery depends on the severity

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and location of the injury.

### **Peripheral Nervous System**

The portion of the nervous system consisting of nerves and ganglia outside the brain and spinal cord. The PNS connects the central nervous system (CNS) to peripheral tissues and organs. Components: (1) Cranial nerves (12 pairs)—emerging from the brain/brainstem, innervating head, neck, and viscera.

### **Peripheral Neuropathy**

A disorder of peripheral nerves causing sensory, motor, and/or autonomic symptoms in a distal, symmetric 'stocking-glove' pattern.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neuropathy, Peripheral Peripheral Neuritis (Peripheral Neuropathy)

### **Periprosthetic Joint Infection**

Infection involving a joint prosthesis and adjacent tissues. Diagnosis integrates clinical findings, inflammatory markers, joint-fluid analysis and culture, and imaging; treatment may require debridement, implant retention, staged exchange, or resection arthroplasty.

### **Perirenal Extramedullary Hematopoiesis**

Formation of blood cells in the tissue surrounding the kidney, occurring as a compensatory response to chronic severe anemia such as myelofibrosis or thalassemia major.

### **Peristalsis**

Peristalsis is coordinated, wave-like contraction of smooth muscle that propels food, fluid, or other contents through the gastrointestinal tract and some ducts.

### **Peritoneal Carcinomatosis**

Diffuse metastatic seeding of the peritoneal cavity from gastrointestinal or ovarian malignancies. Presents with ascites, bowel obstruction, and cachexia. Diagnosed by CT and paracentesis showing malignant cells. Prognosis is generally poor.

### **Peritoneal Dialysis**

Dialysis using peritoneum as semipermeable membrane. CAPD with four manual exchanges daily or APD using cyclor overnight. Advantages include home-based therapy and hemodynamic stability. Complications include peritonitis and catheter infection. Tenckhoff catheter is standard access.

### **Peritoneal Dialysis Catheter**

Flexible tube surgically placed into the peritoneal cavity for peritoneal dialysis. The Tenckhoff catheter is the most commonly used type with one or two cuffs that promote tissue ingrowth and anchor the catheter. Placement can be done surgically, laparoscopically, or percutaneously under radiological guidance.

### **Peritoneal Infection**

Infection of the lining of the abdominal cavity, often called peritonitis. Causes include a ruptured appendix or bowel, abdominal surgery, pelvic infection, or contamination during dialysis. Severe abdominal pain, fever, vomiting, or a rigid abdomen requires urgent assessment.

### **Peritoneum**

The serous membrane lining the abdominal cavity and covering the abdominal organs. Parietal peritoneum lines the abdominal wall (innervated by somatic nerves—pain is well-localized); visceral peritoneum covers organs (innervated by visceral afferents—pain is dull, poorly localized).

### **Peritonitis**

Peritonitis is inflammation or infection of the peritoneum, often from perforation, surgery, ascites infection, or abdominal disease, and may cause severe pain, ileus, sepsis, and shock. organ, appendicitis, abdominal trauma, or infection of ascitic fluid. Severe abdominal pain, guarding, fever, vomiting, or shock requires urgent medical evaluation.

### **Peritonitis In PD**

Infection or inflammation of the peritoneum in a person receiving peritoneal dialysis. Cloudy effluent, abdominal pain, or fever requires prompt evaluation

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of the effluent and other causes. Treatment usually includes antibiotics selected for the suspected organisms; recurrent or refractory infection may require catheter removal.

### **Peritonsillar Abscess**

A collection of pus beside the tonsil, usually developing as a complication of tonsillar infection. See Quinsy.

### **Periungual Fibroma**

Benign, flesh-colored or pink fibrous tumors arising from the nail fold or nail bed, presenting as firm, exophytic nodules that may distort the nail plate. They occur sporadically or in association with tuberous sclerosis complex. When multiple periungual fibromas are present, they raise suspicion for tuberous sclerosis.

### **Periventricular Leukomalacia**

Ischemic white matter injury in the premature infant brain, a major cause of cerebral palsy. Risk factors include prematurity, hypotension, and inflammation. Diagnosis by cranial ultrasound showing periventricular echodensities or cystic changes. Prevention: avoiding hypotension, maintaining normothermia, and managing infection.

### **Permissive Hypercapnia**

A ventilator strategy that allows PaCO<sub>2</sub> to rise above normal (and pH to fall) in exchange for lung-protective ventilation with lower tidal volumes and airway pressures. It is used in severe ARDS when achieving normal PaCO<sub>2</sub> would require harmful ventilation parameters.

### **Pernicious Anemia**

A type of vitamin B12 deficiency anemia caused by autoimmune destruction of gastric parietal cells, leading to lack of intrinsic factor and impaired B12 absorption in the terminal ileum.

#### **Synonyms:**

Addison's Anemia (Pernicious Anemia)

### **Peroxisome**

Single-membrane organelles containing oxidative

enzymes (catalase, urate oxidase, D-amino acid oxidase) that produce and degrade hydrogen peroxide (H<sub>2</sub>O<sub>2</sub>).

### **Persistent Asthma**

Asthma requiring daily controller therapy. Mild persistent: symptoms > 2 days/week but not daily. Moderate persistent: daily symptoms, nighttime awakenings > 1/week. Severe persistent: symptoms throughout the day, frequent nighttime awakenings, SABA use several times/day, extremely limited activity.

### **Persistent Depressive Disorder**

formerly called dysthymia, a chronic depressive mood lasting at least two years in adults (one year in children and adolescents).

### **Persistent Organic Pollutant**

POCPs: organochlorines, PCBs, dioxins. Bioaccumulate, long-range transport, persistent. Stockholm Convention bans/restricts.

### **Persistent Pulmonary Hypertension Of The Newborn**

Failure of the normal fall in pulmonary vascular resistance after birth, causing right-to-left shunting and hypoxaemia. Management requires urgent neonatal respiratory and circulatory support.

### **Persistent Pupillary Membranes**

Remnants of the fetal tunica vasculosa lentis that fail to regress after birth, appearing as fine pigmented strands bridging across the pupil or attaching from the iris collarette to the lens capsule. They are usually benign and asymptomatic but may rarely obstruct the visual axis requiring surgical or laser treatment.

### **Personal Protective Equipment**

PPE: gloves, gowns, masks, eye protection. Used based on transmission-based precautions.

### **Personality Disorder**

A group of mental disorders characterized by en-

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during maladaptive patterns of thinking, feeling, and behaving that deviate from cultural expectations and cause functional impairment. Cluster A (odd/eccentric): paranoid, schizoid, schizotypal. Cluster B (dramatic/erratic): antisocial, borderline, histrionic, narcissistic.

### Personalized Medicine

An approach that uses a person's biological, clinical, and sometimes genetic information to guide prevention, diagnosis, or treatment.

### Pessaries

Devices inserted into the vagina to support pelvic organs in cases of pelvic organ prolapse (cystocele, rectocele, uterine prolapse). Types: ring pessary (most common, with or without supportive membrane), shelf pessary (for severe prolapse), cube pessary (suction-based), and Gellhorn pessary (for advanced prolapse).

### PET Scan (Positron Emission Tomography)

Nuclear medicine imaging using radioactive tracers (most commonly FDG, a glucose analog) to detect metabolically active tissues.

#### Synonyms:

Positron Emission Tomography

### PET Scanner

Ring of detectors capturing coincidence events. BGO, LSO, or LYSO crystals. Time-of-flight PET improves signal-to-noise.

### PET Tracers

18F-FDG: glucose metabolism (cancer, infection, inflammation). 18F-fluoride: bone turnover. 11C-metionine: protein synthesis. 68Ga-DOTATATE: somatostatin receptors. 68Ga-PSMA: prostate cancer.

### PET/CT

Combined PET and CT imaging. CT provides anatomical localization and attenuation correction. Essential for accurate interpretation. Low-dose CT for attenuation correction; diagnostic CT for de-

tailed anatomy.

### PET/MRI

Combined PET and MRI. Superior soft tissue contrast, no ionizing radiation from CT. Useful for neurology, oncology, cardiology. Longer scan time, higher cost.

### Peutz-Jeghers Syndrome

An autosomal dominant neurocutaneous disorder caused by germline loss-of-function mutations in the STK11 (LKB1) tumor suppressor gene on chromosome 19p13.

#### Synonyms:

PJS

### Peutz-Jeghers's Syndrome

An autosomal dominant condition caused by STK11 gene mutations, characterized by hamartomatous polyps throughout the gastrointestinal tract and mucocutaneous hyperpigmented macules on the lips, buccal mucosa, and digits. The polyps may cause gastrointestinal bleeding, intussusception, and obstruction.

### Peyronie Disease

Fibrous plaque in penis causing curvature, pain, erectile dysfunction. Treatment: observation, medications, injection therapy, surgery.

### Pfeiffer Syndrome

An autosomal dominant craniosynostosis syndrome caused by FGFR1 or FGFR2 mutations. Features: craniosynostosis (bilateral coronal), midface hypoplasia, proptosis, hypertelorism, broad thumbs and great toes (medial deviation), and variable syndactyly.

#### Synonyms:

Syndrome Pfeiffer (Pfeiffer Syndrome)

### PH

Measure of hydrogen ion concentration:  $\text{pH} = -\log[\text{H}^+]$ . Normal blood pH: 7.35-7.45. Acidemia:  $\text{pH} < 7.35$ . Alkalemia:  $\text{pH} > 7.45$ . Buffers minimize pH changes.



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## PH Monitoring

Measurement of esophageal pH. Evaluates gastroesophageal reflux disease.

## Phacoemulsification

A cataract-surgery technique that uses ultrasound to break up and remove the cloudy lens through a small incision. An intraocular lens is usually implanted to restore focusing ability.

## Phalen Test

Wrist flexion test for carpal tunnel syndrome. Symptoms reproduced within 60 seconds.

## Phantom

Device simulating human anatomy for quality control and calibration. Types: line source, uniform, Jaszczak, NEMA IU body phantom.

## Phantom Limb Pain

Painful sensations perceived in a limb that has been amputated, caused by persistent or reorganized activity in peripheral nerves and central sensory pathways. It may feel burning, shooting, cramping, or electric.

## Phantosmia

Perception of a smell when no corresponding odor is present. It may occur with sinonasal disease, migraine, seizures involving olfactory networks, head injury, neurodegenerative disease, infection, or other neurological conditions.

## Pharmacodynamic Interaction

A drug interaction in which one drug changes the effect of another at its site of action without necessarily changing its concentration. Effects may be additive, synergistic, or antagonistic, such as combined respiratory depression or bleeding risk.

## Pharmacogenetics

Pharmacogenetics studies how inherited genetic variation alters a person's response to medicines, including efficacy, metabolism, and adverse-effect risk, to support individualized prescribing. toxicity),

CYP2C9/VKORC1 (warfarin dosing), HLA-B\*1502 (carbamazepine SJS in Asians), HLA-B\*5701 (abacavir hypersensitivity), UGT1A1 (irinotecan toxicity).

## Pharmacogenomics

The study of how genetic variations influence individual responses to drugs, including drug efficacy, toxicity, and metabolism. Genetic polymorphisms in drug-metabolizing enzymes, transporters, and receptors can lead to significant inter-individual variability in drug response.

## Pharmacokinetic Interaction

A drug interaction that changes absorption, distribution, metabolism, or excretion of another drug, thereby altering its concentration over time. Enzyme inhibition, enzyme induction, transporter effects, and altered gastric pH are common mechanisms.

## Pharmacological Stress Test

Stress testing using medications (dobutamine, adenosine, regadenoson). For patients unable to exercise.

## Pharmacovigilance

The science and activities relating to the detection, assessment, understanding, and prevention of adverse drug reactions and other drug-related problems.

## Pharyngeal Tonsil

The adenoid tissue located in the roof of the nasopharynx, behind the nose.

## Phase I Metabolism

Phase I metabolism involves chemical modification of drug molecules through oxidation, reduction, and hydrolysis reactions, primarily catalyzed by the cytochrome P450 enzyme system in the liver.

## Phase II Metabolism

Phase II metabolism, also known as conjugation reactions, involves the attachment of endogenous hy-



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drophilic molecules to drugs or their Phase I metabolites, dramatically increasing water solubility and facilitating renal excretion.

**Synonyms:**

conjugation reactions, involves the attachment of.

**Phencyclidine**

A dissociative drug that can cause altered perception, agitation, hallucinations, impaired coordination, or dangerous behavior.

**Phenotype**

Observable characteristics of an individual, resulting from genotype and environmental interactions. Includes morphology, development, biochemical properties, behavior.

**Phenylketonuria**

Phenylketonuria is an inherited inability to metabolize phenylalanine, allowing toxic accumulation that can impair brain development without early dietary treatment. accumulation of phenylalanine and reduced tyrosine availability. Untreated disease can cause intellectual disability, seizures, eczema, and a musty odor; newborn screening and dietary treatment are effective.

**Phlebography**

Venography using contrast dye. Used for diagnosing venous thrombosis, malformations. Largely replaced by duplex ultrasound.

**Phlegmasia Cerulea Dolens**

Phlegmasia cerulea dolens is a severe, extensive deep-vein thrombosis that obstructs venous outflow, causing painful swollen blue discoloration and risking limb ischemia or pulmonary embolism.

**Phobias**

Persistent, excessive fear of a specific object or situation that leads to avoidance or significant distress.

**Phosphate Binders**

Calcium acetate, sevelamer, lanthanum. Bind dietary phosphate in GI tract. Target normal serum

phosphorus in CKD-MBD. Avoid calcium-based binders in patients with vascular calcification.

**Phosphate Homeostasis**

Serum phosphate is regulated by the interplay of PTH vitamin D and fibroblast growth factor 23. PTH promotes renal phosphate excretion. Active vitamin D stimulates intestinal phosphate absorption. FGF23 produced by osteocytes inhibits renal phosphate reabsorption and suppresses 1-alpha-hydroxylase reducing active vitamin D production.

**Phosphodiesterase Inhibitor**

A class of drugs that inhibit phosphodiesterase enzymes, which break down cyclic nucleotides (cAMP and cGMP), thereby increasing intracellular levels of these second messengers and potentiating their downstream effects.

**Phosphodiesterase-5 Inhibitors**

Medications that inhibit PDE-5, increasing cGMP and causing smooth muscle relaxation and vasodilation. Sildenafil and tadalafil are used for PAH and erectile dysfunction. In PAH, they reduce pulmonary vascular resistance and improve exercise capacity.

**Phosphofructokinase-1**

Rate-limiting enzyme of glycolysis. Activated by AMP, fructose-2,6-bisphosphate. Inhibited by ATP, citrate.

**Phospholipase C Pathway**

A GPCR signaling pathway activated primarily by Gq-protein coupled receptors (e.g., alpha-1 adrenergic, muscarinic M1/M3, vasopressin V1, angiotensin II AT1 receptors).

**Photoallergy**

An immune-mediated skin reaction that occurs when ultraviolet light activates a sensitizing substance on or in the skin, causing an eczematous rash.

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### Photocoagulation

Coagulation of tissue by intense light, often laser light, to treat lesions such as abnormal retinal vessels.

### Photodynamic Therapy

A treatment that combines a photosensitizing agent with light to generate reactive oxygen species and destroy cancer cells, used for actinic keratosis, superficial skin cancers, and selected visceral tumors.

### Photoelectric Effect

Photon absorption by inner shell electron. Major interaction at low energies, high Z materials.

### Photomultiplier Tube

Converts light photons to electrical signals. Array of PMTs positioned behind crystal. Positioning circuit determines interaction location.

### Photoppeak

Full-energy peak in gamma spectrum. Used for energy window setting.

### Photopheresis

Extracorporeal treatment in which white blood cells are exposed to a photosensitizer and ultraviolet A light before being returned to the patient.

### Photosensitivity

An abnormal skin reaction to sunlight (UVA/UVB), manifesting as rash, erythema, or burning on sun-exposed areas.

### Phototoxic Dermatitis

An acute, dose-dependent inflammatory skin reaction occurring when certain ingested or topically applied chemicals (such as psoralens, tetracyclines, NSAIDs, or thiazides) absorb ultraviolet radiation, leading to direct cellular damage and a sunburn-like eruption in exposed areas.

### Phototoxicity

Skin reaction from UV light + chemical. Sunburn-like. Examples: tetracyclines, thiazides, NSAIDs,

psoralens.

### Phyllodes Tumor

A breast tumor composed of both stromal and epithelial elements, ranging from benign through borderline to malignant. Typically a large, rapidly growing mass; treatment is surgical excision with clear margins.

### Physiatrist

Physician specialty focusing on function, quality of life for patients with impairment, disability. See rehabilitation medicine.

### Physical Half-Life

The time required for half of the radioactive nuclei in a sample to undergo nuclear decay. It is distinct from biologic half-life, which describes biological elimination, and effective half-life, which combines both processes.

### Physical Therapy Assessment

Comprehensive evaluation: history, observation, ROM, strength, sensation, coordination, balance, gait, functional tasks.

### Physiologic Jaundice Of Newborn

A common, benign condition characterized by unconjugated hyperbilirubinemia appearing after 24 hours of age (peak at 3-5 days) in healthy term newborns. Caused by increased bilirubin production (high RBC turnover, short RBC lifespan) and immature hepatic conjugation (low UDP-glucuronyl transferase activity).

### Physiological Dead Space

Volume of ventilated respiratory tract that does not participate in gas exchange, including anatomic and alveolar dead space.

### Phytomenadione

Vitamin K is a fat-soluble vitamin essential for the post-translational gamma-carboxylation of glutamate residues to gamma-carboxyglutamate (Gla) in specific clotting factors (II, VII, IX, X, protein

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C, protein S) and anticoagulant proteins (protein C, protein S, protein Z). See Vitamin K: Phylloquinone.

### **PI-RADS**

Prostate Imaging-Reporting and Data System. Standardizes multiparametric MRI reporting for prostate cancer detection and staging.

### **Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter**

A long, flexible catheter inserted into the basilic or cephalic vein and advanced so the tip sits in the superior vena cava. Inserted at the bedside, often by a specialized PICC nurse, with ultrasound and ECG or X-ray confirmation. Indications: long-term IV antibiotics (>2 weeks), TPN, chemotherapy, and frequent blood draws.

### **Pierre Robin Sequence**

A congenital anomaly triad: micrognathia (small mandible), glossoptosis (posteriorly displaced tongue causing airway obstruction), and U-shaped cleft palate. The sequence arises from early mandibular hypoplasia, which prevents the tongue from descending, thereby impairing palatal shelf fusion.

### **Pierson Syndrome**

A rare autosomal-recessive disorder caused by LAMB2 variants, classically combining congenital nephrotic syndrome with microcoria and structural abnormalities of the eyes. Kidney failure, developmental impairment, and severe visual disability may occur.

### **Pigment Cirrhosis**

Liver cirrhosis associated with abnormal pigment or iron deposition, as may occur in hereditary hemochromatosis.

### **Pigmentary Mosaicism**

A pattern of alternating hyperpigmented and hypopigmented skin patches arranged in a linear, segmental, or blaschkoid distribution, caused by genetic mosaicism from post-zygotic mutations affecting melanocyte development. It is a cosmetic condition

without systemic involvement.

### **Pilar Cyst**

A benign cyst arising from the outer root sheath of hair follicles, most commonly on the scalp. It presents as a firm, mobile, subcutaneous nodule without a central punctum. Unlike epidermoid cysts, pilar cysts have smooth walls and contain dense keratin. They may be multiple in familial cases. Treatment is simple excision.

### **Piles (Hemorrhoids)**

Swollen, inflamed vascular cushions in the anal canal that normally aid continence. Internal hemorrhoids (above the dentate line, painless) present with painless bright red rectal bleeding and prolapse; graded I-IV by degree of prolapse.

#### **Synonyms:**

Hemorrhoids

### **Pilonidal Disease**

A chronic inflammatory condition of the sacrococcygeal region involving hair follicles. Pilonidal sinus: epithelialized tract containing hair and debris. Pilonidal abscess: acute infection of the sinus. Most common in young, hirsute males, exacerbated by prolonged sitting, obesity, and local trauma.

### **Pilonidal Sinus Disease**

A chronic sinus or cyst in the natal cleft, usually containing hair and debris. It may cause recurrent pain, swelling, drainage, or abscess formation.

### **Pineal Gland Tumor**

A tumor of the pineal region, including germinoma, pineocytoma, and pineoblastoma. Presents with Parinaud syndrome, hydrocephalus, and raised intracranial pressure; germinomas are highly radiosensitive.

### **Pinguecula**

A pinguecula is a benign yellowish raised growth on the conjunctiva near the cornea, often associated with ultraviolet light, wind, and dust; it may irritate the eye.

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### **Pink Puffer**

A clinical phenotype of emphysema in COPD. Patients present with severe dyspnea, minimal cough, thin habitus, pursed-lip breathing, accessory muscle use, and relatively normal PaO<sub>2</sub> with late hypercapnia. They tend to be older and have more extensive emphysema.

### **Pure-Tone Audiometry**

A hearing test that measures the softest tones a person can hear at selected frequencies through air and bone conduction. The results are plotted on an audiogram and help distinguish conductive from sensorineural hearing loss.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pure-tone threshold audiometry; pure-tone hearing test.

### **Piriformis Syndrome**

Sciatic nerve compression by piriformis muscle. Buttock pain, radiating down leg. Diagnosis: clinical, exclude disc herniation. Treatment: stretching, injection, surgical release.

#### **Synonyms:**

PiriformSyndrome (Piriformis Syndrome)

### **Pisiform**

Small pea-shaped sesamoid bone in the flexor carpi ulnaris tendon, in the proximal row. Articulates only with the triquetrum. Forms the medial border of Guyon's canal (ulnar nerve/artery passage). Only sesamoid carpal bone, subcutaneous and easily palpable on the ulnar palm.

### **Pituitary Adenoma**

Pituitary adenomas are benign neoplasms arising from the adenohypophysis (anterior pituitary gland), accounting for approximately ten to fifteen percent of all intracranial neoplasms.

### **Pituitary Apoplexy**

Acute hemorrhage or infarction within a pituitary adenoma causing sudden headache, visual field defects, ophthalmoplegia, and altered consciousness. Medical emergency requiring urgent glucocorticoid administration to prevent adrenal crisis from acute

ACTH deficiency.

### **Pituitary Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving pituitary Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Pityriasis Rosea**

An acute, self-limited eruption often beginning with a herald patch followed by oval scaly lesions distributed along skin-cleavage lines. It usually resolves within several weeks; treatment is symptomatic, and atypical, severe, recurrent, or persistent disease should be reassessed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pityriasis Rosea Gibert (Pityriasis Rosea)

### **Placebo Effect**

A psychological and physiological phenomenon where a patient experiences a real improvement in health or symptoms after receiving an inactive treatment (like a sugar pill) due to their expectations of healing.

### **Placenta Increta**

Abnormal placental invasion into the myometrium without reaching the serosa, increasing the risk of massive hemorrhage at delivery and often requiring cesarean hysterectomy.

### **Placental Abruption**

Premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall before delivery. It may cause vaginal bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fetal distress, and maternal or fetal compromise.

### **Placental Accreta Spectrum**

Abnormal placental attachment to the myometrium, ranging from accreta (adherent to decidua basalis) to increta (invading myometrium) to percreta (invading through serosa). Major risk factor is prior caesarean section with anterior placenta previa.

### **Placental Separation Signs**

Clinical signs indicating the placenta has separated

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from the uterine wall and is ready for delivery. Classic signs: lengthening of the umbilical cord (cord lengthens as the placenta descends), a sudden gush of blood, and uterine elevation and firming (the uterus rises and becomes globular as the placenta moves into the lower segment).

### **Plant Thorn Synovitis**

Inflammation of a joint after penetration by a plant thorn or splinter, sometimes involving an infection introduced by the injury. Symptoms may develop gradually as persistent joint pain, swelling, and limited movement; evaluation may require removal of retained material and targeted treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis Plant Thorn (Plant Thorn Synovitis)

### **Plantar Fasciitis**

The most common cause of heel pain, caused by degeneration and microtears of the plantar fascia at its calcaneal origin. Presents with sharp, stabbing heel pain with the first steps in the morning (post-static dyskinesia), improving after a few minutes but worsening with prolonged standing or activity.

### **Plantar Wart (Verruca Plantaris)**

A wart (verruca) located on the sole of the foot, caused by human papillomavirus (HPV, typically types 1, 2, 4, 63). Plantar warts are endophytic (grow inward due to pressure) rather than exophytic like common warts, and are often painful with direct pressure (walking, standing).

#### **Synonyms:**

Verruca Plantaris

### **Palatoschisis**

A congenital cleft or failure of fusion of the palate, commonly called cleft palate, which may affect feeding, speech, hearing, and dental development.

### **Preimplantation Genetic Testing**

Genetic testing of cells from an embryo created through in-vitro fertilization before possible transfer to the uterus, used in selected situations to identify specific inherited disorders or chromosome-number abnormalities.

### **Physostigmine**

A reversible acetylcholinesterase inhibitor that may reverse severe central anticholinergic delirium in carefully selected patients after assessment for contraindications and cardiac conduction abnormalities.

### **Periodic Fever, Aphthous Stomatitis, Pharyngitis, Adenitis Syndrome**

A recurrent fever syndrome, usually beginning in childhood, characterized by periodic fever with some combination of mouth ulcers, sore throat, and swollen neck lymph nodes; it is commonly abbreviated PFAPA.

### **Prodromal**

Describing early, nonspecific signs or symptoms that occur before the characteristic clinical features of a disease become apparent.

### **Parathyroid Glands**

Usually four small endocrine glands located behind the thyroid that secrete parathyroid hormone (PTH). PTH maintains calcium and phosphate balance by acting on bone, kidneys, and indirectly the intestine through vitamin D activation.

### **Pedunculated**

Attached to the skin or another surface by a narrow stalk, rather than having a broad base.

### **Perineal**

Relating to the perineum, the region between the external genitalia and the anus.

### **Periorbital**

Located around or surrounding the orbit and eyelids.

### **Photodermatosis**

A skin disorder caused or aggravated by exposure to ultraviolet or visible light, including polymorphous light eruption, phototoxic reactions, and photoallergic reactions.

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## Polymorphous

Having lesions or clinical features that differ in shape, size, or stage and therefore show multiple forms.

## Plantar Warts

Common warts (verrucae) occurring on the plantar surface of the foot, caused by human papillomavirus infection of the keratinocytes. They present as hard, thickened papules with a rough surface and disrupted dermatoglyphics (skin lines), often with pinpoint black dots representing thrombosed capillaries.

### Synonyms:

Warts, Plantar

## Plaque Assay

A method for quantifying viruses: serial dilutions of a viral suspension are added to a monolayer of host cells, forming zones of cell destruction (plaques), each plaque representing one infectious unit; results expressed as plaque-forming units per mL (PFU/mL).

## Plasma Cell

The terminally differentiated antibody-secreting cell derived from activated B lymphocytes (after antigen stimulation, class switching, and affinity maturation in germinal centers).

## Plasma Cell Myeloma

A malignant neoplasm of clonal plasma cells, usually producing a monoclonal immunoglobulin or light chain. It may cause hypercalcemia, renal impairment, anemia, and destructive bone lesions, collectively known as CRAB features, together with recurrent infection and hyperviscosity in some patients.

## Plasma Concentration

The amount of a substance present in a defined volume of plasma at a given time. It is used to interpret exposure, toxicity, therapeutic drug monitoring, and pharmacokinetic relationships.

## Plasmids

Small, circular, extrachromosomal DNA elements that replicate independently of the bacterial chromosome. Plasmids carry non-essential genes that provide selective advantages including antibiotic resistance, virulence factors, and metabolic capabilities.

## Plasmodium Vivax

A malaria parasite transmitted by *Anopheles* mosquitoes. It infects red blood cells and can persist in the liver as dormant hypnozoites that cause relapses.

## Plastic Bronchitis

A rare condition producing large, branching mucous casts that form in the airways, causing life-threatening airway obstruction, often associated with congenital heart disease or post-fontan circulation.

## Plate Method

Simple portion control: half plate vegetables, quarter plate protein, quarter plate grains. Promotes balanced eating.

## Platelet Aggregation

The adhesion and clumping of platelets to form a hemostatic plug at sites of vascular injury.

## Platelet Function Disorders

Conditions in which platelets do not adhere, activate, or aggregate normally, causing impaired primary hemostasis. They may be inherited or acquired and can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or bleeding after procedures.

## Platelet Plug Formation

The initial hemostatic response to vascular injury, involving platelet adhesion, activation, and aggregation. When the endothelium is disrupted, subendothelial von Willebrand factor and collagen are exposed to flowing blood.



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### **Platelets (Thrombocytes)**

Small, anucleate, disc-shaped cell fragments (2–4  $\mu\text{m}$  diameter) derived from megakaryocytes in the bone marrow, circulating at  $150\text{--}400 \times 10^9/\text{L}$ .

#### **Synonyms:**

Thrombocytes

### **Platypnea**

Dyspnea that occurs in the upright position and is relieved by lying down. It is the opposite of orthopnea. It is rare and may be associated with hepatopulmonary syndrome, intracardiac shunting, or pulmonary arteriovenous malformations.

### **Pleiotropy**

Single gene influencing multiple phenotypic traits. Examples: phenylketonuria (PKU) affects multiple systems; sickle cell anemia causes anemia, pain crises, organ damage.

### **Pleomorphic Adenoma**

A usually benign salivary-gland tumor composed of epithelial and connective-tissue elements. It most often occurs in the parotid gland and may slowly enlarge; long-standing lesions can rarely undergo malignant transformation.

### **Pleomorphism**

Variation in the size and shape of cells or their nuclei within a tissue. Marked pleomorphism is a feature of many high-grade malignancies but can also occur in some reactive or degenerative conditions.

### **Pleural Cavity**

The narrow, fluid-filled space between the two layers of the pleura surrounding each lung.

### **Pleural Fluid Glucose**

Pleural-fluid glucose may be reduced in empyema, complicated parapneumonic effusion, rheumatoid pleuritis, tuberculosis, and malignancy. It is interpreted with pH, cell count, protein, LDH, microbiology, imaging, and the clinical setting.

### **Pleural Fluid PH**

Pleural-fluid pH helps assess infection and other causes of effusion. A markedly low pH supports a complicated parapneumonic effusion in the appropriate clinical setting, but drainage decisions also depend on imaging, fluid appearance, microbiology, glucose, and the patient's condition.

### **Pleural Friction Rub**

A grating, leathery sound heard on auscultation caused by inflamed pleural surfaces rubbing against each other during breathing. It is a sign of pleurisy and may be heard in pneumonia, PE, and pleural effusion. It disappears when fluid accumulates and separates the pleural surfaces.

### **Pleural Perforation**

A breach in the pleural lining allowing air or fluid to enter the pleural space, potentially causing pneumothorax or hydropneumothorax, often from trauma, procedures, or underlying lung disease.

### **Pleural Plaque**

Circumscribed fibrous tissue on parietal pleura, hallmark of asbestos exposure. Bilateral, often calcified. Does not indicate asbestosis.

### **Pleurectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the pleura, used in the treatment of malignant pleural mesothelioma and recurrent malignant pleural effusion.

### **Pleuritis**

Inflammation of the pleural membranes (visceral and parietal pleura). Presents with pleuritic chest pain: sharp, stabbing pain exacerbated by deep breathing, coughing, or sneezing.

### **Pleurodesis**

Fusion of visceral and parietal pleura to prevent recurrence of effusions or pneumothorax. Chemical pleurodesis uses talc, doxycycline, or bleomycin.

### **Plug (Vascular)**

A vascular occlusion device used to block a selected

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vessel under image guidance.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

**Pneumatic Otoscopy**

A diagnostic technique that combines visualization of the tympanic membrane with assessment of its mobility in response to positive and negative air pressure changes, providing information about the presence of middle ear fluid and the condition of the Eustachian tube.

**Pneumatic Retinopexy**

A procedure for selected retinal detachments in which an intravitreal gas bubble is injected and laser or cryotherapy seals the retinal break while positioning helps the bubble support the repair.

**Pneumatosis Cystoides Coli**

Condition characterized by multiple gas-filled cysts within the wall of the colon, which may be primary (idiopathic) or secondary to intestinal mucosal disruption from conditions such as chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, ischemic bowel disease, or intestinal obstruction. Often discovered incidentally on imaging or colonoscopy.

**Pneumatosis Cystoides Intestinalis**

Gas-filled cysts within the bowel wall that may be primary or secondary to bowel ischemia, infection, chronic lung disease, or medications. Often an incidental finding on imaging. Primary pneumatosis is benign and asymptomatic. Secondary pneumatosis may indicate serious underlying disease. Managed by treating the underlying condition.

**Pneumatosis Intestinalis**

Presence of gas within the bowel wall appearing as linear or cystic radiolucencies on imaging. Primary pneumatosis is benign and idiopathic accounting for approximately fifteen percent of cases.

**Pneumocephalus**

The presence of air or gas within the cranial cavity, most commonly following trauma, surgery, or sinus disease, and potentially causing increased intracra-

nial pressure if tension develops.

**Pneumococcal Conjugate Vaccine**

A vaccine that links pneumococcal polysaccharides to a carrier protein to produce protective immunity against selected *Streptococcus pneumoniae* serotypes. Product choice and schedule depend on age, vaccination history, medical risk, and local recommendations.

**Pneumococcal Sepsis**

Sepsis caused by *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, often arising from pneumonia, meningitis, or another invasive pneumococcal infection.

**Pneumocystis Jirovecii Pneumonia**

Opportunistic pneumonia caused by *Pneumocystis jirovecii*, especially in people with advanced HIV infection or other cellular immunodeficiency. It causes progressive exertional dyspnea, dry cough, fever, and hypoxemia.

**Pneumocystis Pneumonia**

Opportunistic pneumonia caused by *Pneumocystis jirovecii*, usually in people with impaired cell-mediated immunity. It may cause progressive exertional dyspnea, dry cough, fever, and hypoxemia with diffuse ground-glass changes. Diagnosis and treatment require clinical, microbiologic, and radiologic assessment; trimethoprim-sulfamethoxazole is commonly used.

**Pneumography**

Contrast imaging of body cavities. Pneumoencephalography obsolete. Pneumoperitoneum for laparoscopy.

**Pneumopericardium**

Air in the pericardial space, usually from trauma (penetrating chest injury), esophageal perforation, or iatrogenic causes (central line placement, cardiac surgery). Can cause cardiac tamponade if under tension. Diagnosis by chest X-ray showing air surrounding the heart (air-fluid level if combined with effusion).

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## POEMS Syndrome

A rare plasma-cell disorder named for polyneuropathy, organomegaly, endocrinopathy, monoclonal plasma-cell disorder, and skin changes. Other manifestations include sclerotic bone lesions, papilledema, fluid overload, thrombocytosis, and elevated vascular endothelial growth factor.

## Point Mutation

Change in single nucleotide base pair. Substitutions: transition (purine to purine, pyrimidine to pyrimidine) or transversion (purine to pyrimidine). Effects: silent (same amino acid), missense (different amino acid), nonsense (stop codon).

## Point-Of-Care Testing

Diagnostic testing performed near the patient rather than in a central laboratory. POCT can shorten turnaround time but requires validated devices, quality control, operator training, and appropriate interpretation.

## Point-Of-Care Ultrasound

Bedside ultrasonography performed and interpreted by the treating clinician to answer focused diagnostic or procedural questions. Emergency applications include cardiac activity, volume status, pulmonary pathology, abdominal free fluid, vascular thrombosis, and procedural guidance.

## Poison Control

A specialized service that provides immediate advice about exposure to medicines, chemicals, or other potential poisons.

## Poison-Center Consultation

Specialist toxicology advice used to identify hazards, interpret exposure and laboratory data, select antidotes, guide observation or disposition, and coordinate public-health response. Consultation is appropriate for significant, uncertain, mixed, pediatric, or unusual exposures.

## Poland Syndrome

A congenital condition characterized by absence or underdevelopment of part of the pectoral muscles on

one side, sometimes accompanied by abnormalities of the hand on the same side.

## Polio

Polio is poliomyelitis, an infection caused by poliovirus, an enterovirus of the Picornaviridae family. It is usually asymptomatic or mild but can cause meningitis or irreversible asymmetric flaccid paralysis; transmission is primarily fecal-oral.

## Poliovirus

An enterovirus that causes poliomyelitis. It is transmitted mainly by the fecal-oral route; most infections are asymptomatic, but a small proportion cause meningitis or acute flaccid paralysis by damaging motor neurons in the spinal cord. Diagnosis uses molecular testing, usually reverse-transcription PCR of stool or other appropriate specimens.

## Polish (Dental)

Smoothing restorative surfaces to reduce plaque accumulation. Essential for longevity.

### Synonyms:

Dental

## Polyarteritis Nodosa

Necrotizing inflammation of medium-sized muscular arteries, spares lungs. Associated with hepatitis B (10-30%). Clinical: systemic symptoms, mononeuritis multiplex, livedo reticularis, renal involvement (hypertension, renal insufficiency—no glomerulonephritis), GI ischemia.

### Synonyms:

PAN (Polyarteritis Nodosa)

## Polychondritis

Relapsing inflammatory disorder targeting cartilage throughout the body, causing pain, swelling, and destruction of the ears, nose, larynx, trachea, and joints. May lead to airway collapse and hearing loss.

## Polycystic Liver Disease

Dominant polycystic liver disease is an autosomal dominant condition characterized by multiple hepatic cysts that may cause massive hepatomegaly,

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abdominal pain, and compressive symptoms. Usually associated with autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease. Liver function is preserved even with extensive cyst involvement.

### **Polycystic Ovary Syndrome**

Common endocrine disorder affecting six to twelve percent of reproductive-aged women characterized by hyperandrogenism, ovulatory dysfunction, and polycystic ovarian morphology on ultrasound.

### **Polycythemia**

Elevated red blood cell mass/hematocrit. Primary: polycythemia vera (JAK2 V617F mutation, trilineage proliferation, low EPO, risk of thrombosis and myelofibrosis/leukemia). Secondary: hypoxia (COPD, high altitude, congenital heart disease, sleep apnea) with high EPO, or EPO-secreting tumors (renal cell, hepatoma).

### **Polycythemia Vera**

A chronic myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by increased red blood cell mass, often with increased white blood cell and platelet counts, driven by constitutive activation of the JAK-STAT signaling pathway.

#### **Synonyms:**

Primary Polycythemia

### **Polydactylysm**

Congenital presence of extra fingers or toes.

### **Polygenic Inheritance**

Trait influenced by multiple genes, each with small effect. Examples: height, skin color, common diseases (diabetes, heart disease). Produces continuous variation.

### **Polygenic Risk Score**

A statistical estimate of disease susceptibility calculated from the combined effects of many genetic variants, each usually contributing a small amount of risk. It modifies but does not replace clinical risk assessment or environmental factors.

### **Polyhydramnios**

A clinical finding or condition involving polyhydramnios; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Polymerase Chain Reaction**

An in-vitro method that exponentially amplifies a defined DNA segment through repeated cycles of denaturation, primer annealing, and DNA synthesis by a thermostable polymerase. It is used in diagnosis, research, forensics, and pathogen detection.

### **Polymicrobial Infections**

Infections caused by multiple microbial species. Polymicrobial infections are common in wound infections, intra-abdominal infections, and respiratory infections. The interactions between organisms can be synergistic or antagonistic. Understanding polymicrobial infections is essential for selecting appropriate antimicrobial therapy.

### **Polymicrogyria**

A brain malformation characterized by an excessive number of abnormally small, fused gyri, resulting in an irregular, bumpy cortical surface with shallow sulci. Caused by abnormal late neuronal migration or post-migrational cortical organization. May be focal or diffuse, unilateral or bilateral, and symmetric or asymmetric.

### **Polyp Surveillance Colonoscopy**

Interval-based endoscopic follow-up of patients with previously identified colorectal polyps. Intervals are determined by polyp number, size, and histological features. One to two small adenomas require surveillance at seven to ten years. Three to four adenomas at three to five years.

### **Polyphagia**

Excessive, uncontrollable hunger or increased appetite. Classic cardinal symptom of uncontrolled Diabetes Mellitus (cellular starvation due to lack of insulin or insulin resistance), Hyperthyroidism (elevated basal metabolic rate), Prader-Willi Syndrome, and atypical depression.

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## Polypharmacy

Use of multiple medications by one patient, often defined numerically as five or more concurrent medicines. It increases the risk of interactions, adverse effects, prescribing cascades, nonadherence, and medication errors, although some multidrug regimens are clinically appropriate.

## Polysomnography

Polysomnography examines polysomnography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. Diagnoses sleep apnea, parasomnias.

## Polysomnography (Sleep Study)

Overnight monitoring for sleep-disordered breathing. Parameters: EEG (sleep staging: N1, N2, N3, REM), EOG (eye movements), EMG (chin and leg movements), airflow (nasal pressure, thermistor), respiratory effort (chest/abdomen belts), snore microphone, body position, oximetry (SpO2), and ECG.

**Synonyms:**  
Sleep Study

## Polyunsaturated Fat

Liquid at room temperature. Sources: fish, vegetable oils, nuts. Essential fatty acids.

## Popliteal Aneurysm

Aneurysm of popliteal artery behind knee. Associated with AAA. Risk: thrombosis, embolism, compression. Treatment: surgical repair or endovascular stenting.

## Popliteal Artery

Continues from femoral artery at the adductor hiatus, dividing into anterior/posterior tibial arteries at the lower popliteus border. Deepest popliteal fossa structure, related anteriorly to vein and tibial nerve. Palpable at the fossa's inferior margin.

## Popliteal Fossa

Diamond-shaped space on the posterior knee, bounded by hamstrings superiorly and gastroc-

nemius heads inferiorly. Contains popliteal artery/vein, tibial nerve, and common peroneal nerve. The popliteal pulse is palpated at the inferior margin.

## Population Attributable Fraction

The proportion of cases or disease burden in the total population that would theoretically be prevented if the exposure were eliminated, assuming the exposure is causal and other conditions remain unchanged.

## Population Attributable Risk

Proportion of disease in population attributable to exposure.  $PAR = (\text{incidence total} - \text{incidence unexposed}) / \text{incidence total}$ .

## Porcelain Gallbladder

Calcification of the gallbladder wall visible on imaging representing chronic inflammatory condition associated with cholelithiasis and chronic cholecystitis. Historically considered a strong risk factor for gallbladder carcinoma, recent studies suggest the cancer risk may be lower than previously estimated.

## Porphyria Cutanea Tarda

The most common porphyria, caused by a deficiency of hepatic uroporphyrinogen decarboxylase (UROD), leading to accumulation of uroporphyrinogens. Triggered by hepatitis C virus (HCV), alcohol abuse, iron overload (hemochromatosis), and estrogen therapy.

## Porphyrias

Metabolic disorders of heme synthesis causing cutaneous and neurological symptoms. Cutaneous porphyrias include porphyria cutanea tarda (blisters on sun-exposed skin, hypertrichosis, sclerodermoid changes), erythropoietic protoporphyria (immediate pain and burning on sun exposure without visible changes), and variegate porphyria.

## Portal Hypertension

Elevated pressure in the portal venous system defined as hepatic venous pressure gradient exceeding five millimeters of mercury with clinically significant



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portal hypertension occurring when the gradient exceeds ten.

**Synonyms:**

PHT

**Portal Hypertensive Gastropathy**

Diffuse mucosal changes in the stomach due to portal hypertension causing chronic blood loss. Characterized by mosaic pattern and cherry red spots on endoscopy representing dilated mucosal vessels. Most common in patients with advanced cirrhosis and portal hypertension.

**Portal System**

Venous network draining the GI tract, spleen, and pancreas to the liver via the portal vein (formed by superior mesenteric and splenic vein union behind the pancreatic neck). Carries nutrient-rich deoxygenated blood for hepatic processing before systemic entry. Receives left gastric, right gastric, cystic, and paraumbilical veins.

**Portal Vein**

The vein carrying nutrient-rich blood from the gastrointestinal tract, spleen, pancreas, and gallbladder to the liver, formed behind the pancreatic neck by the union of the superior mesenteric and splenic veins. It enters the porta hepatis with the hepatic artery and bile duct.

**Portal Vein Thrombosis**

Partial or complete thrombosis of the portal vein or its branches. It may result from cirrhosis, malignancy, inflammation, thrombophilia, or abdominal surgery and can cause portal hypertension, intestinal ischemia, or variceal formation.

**Portion Control**

Managing serving sizes. Larger portions available today contribute to obesity. Using smaller plates, reading labels helpful.

**Portopulmonary Syndrome**

Development of pulmonary arterial hypertension in the setting of portal hypertension or liver disease. Results from increased cardiac output and

splanchnic vasodilation leading to pulmonary vascular remodeling.

**Positional Asphyxia**

Fatal or potentially fatal impairment of breathing caused by body position that restricts chest movement, airway patency, or venous return. Risk is increased by restraint, intoxication, obesity, and inability to reposition; findings are nonspecific and require scene and medical correlation.

**Positive End-Expiratory Pressure**

Pressure maintained at end-expiration to prevent alveolar collapse. Improves oxygenation by recruiting alveoli and increasing FRC. Balances oxygenation with hemodynamic effects.

**Positive Predictive Value**

The probability that a person with a positive test result truly has the target condition. PPV depends on test specificity and sensitivity and on disease prevalence or pretest probability in the tested population.

**Positive Predictive Value In Surveillance**

The proportion of reported signals or alerts that represent true events meeting the surveillance case definition. It is influenced by the specificity of the signal and the underlying prevalence of the condition.

**Positive Pressure Ventilation**

Mechanical ventilation that delivers air/oxygen under positive pressure to support or replace spontaneous breathing. Noninvasive (NIV): CPAP (continuous) and BiPAP (two levels) via mask for obstructive sleep apnea, cardiogenic pulmonary edema, and hypercapnic COPD.

**Positive Symptoms**

Symptoms reflecting an excess or distortion of normal mental functions, such as hallucinations, delusions, disorganized speech, or grossly disorganized behavior. They are contrasted with negative symptoms, which reflect loss or reduction of function.



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## Positron

Anti-particle of electron. Emitted by PET radionuclides. Annihilation with electron produces two 511 keV photons.

## Positron Emission Mammography

PET imaging of breast. Higher sensitivity than mammography for dense breasts. Limited availability.

## Positron Emission Tomography

Functional imaging modality using positron-emitting radionuclides. Common isotope: fluorine-18 (110 min half-life). Detection: annihilation photons (511 keV) detected in coincidence. Tracers: FDG (metabolism), florbetapir (amyloid), flortaucipir (tau), PSMA (prostate cancer).

## Post-Acute Rehabilitation

Time-limited interdisciplinary care after an acute illness, injury, or hospitalization to restore mobility, self-care, cognition, communication, and safe community function. Intensity and setting depend on medical stability and rehabilitation potential.

## Post-Cardiac Arrest Management

Care after return of spontaneous circulation that supports breathing and circulation, identifies and treats the cause of the arrest, manages temperature and seizures when indicated, and assesses neurologic recovery over time.

## Post-Concussion Syndrome

Persistent symptoms after concussion: headache, dizziness, cognitive difficulties, sleep disturbance, mood changes. Management: symptom-directed, gradual return to activity.

## Post-Dural Puncture Headache

A positional headache occurring after accidental dural puncture during epidural placement or lumbar puncture, caused by cerebrospinal fluid leakage and intracranial hypotension. Symptoms include frontal or occipital headache worse when upright and relieved when supine, neck stiffness, tinnitus, photophobia, and nausea.

## Post-Exposure Prophylaxis

The administration of antimicrobial agents after exposure to a pathogen to prevent infection. PEP is used for HIV, hepatitis B, hepatitis C, rabies, and other infections. The timing of PEP is critical, with early administration being most effective. Understanding PEP is essential for managing occupational exposures and outbreaks.

## Post-Infectious Cough

A chronic cough persisting 3–8 weeks after a URI, caused by transient bronchial hyperresponsiveness and airway inflammation. It is self-limited and usually resolves without treatment. Inhaled corticosteroids, antitussives, and time are the mainstays of management.

## Post-Obstructive Pneumonia

Pneumonia occurring distal to a bronchial obstruction caused by tumor, foreign body, mucus plug, or stenosis. The obstruction prevents clearance of secretions, creating a favorable environment for infection. It does not resolve with antibiotics alone until the obstruction is relieved.

## Post-Operative Atelectasis

Collapse of some alveoli after surgery, promoted by anesthesia, shallow breathing, pain, immobility, mucus retention, or underlying lung disease. Management addresses the cause and may include mobilization, effective analgesia, deep breathing, and treatment of complications.

## Post-Pneumonectomy Syndrome

A rare complication following pneumonectomy where the remaining lung herniates across the mediastinum, causing compression of airways and vessels. It presents with dyspnea, stridor, and recurrent infections. Treatment is surgical correction with mediastinal repositioning and prosthetic implant placement.

## Post-Streptococcal Glomerulonephritis

Immune-mediated glomerulonephritis following infection with nephritogenic strains of group A streptococcus typically 1 to 3 weeks after pharyngitis

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or 3 to 6 weeks after skin infection. Subepithelial humps on electron microscopy representing immune complex deposits.

### **Post-Surgical Pain**

Acute pain following operative procedures, caused by tissue incision, retraction, dissection, and inflammation, mediated by nociceptors sensitized by prostaglandins, bradykinin, and cytokines. Intensity varies by procedure (thoracotomy, joint replacement, and laparotomy produce more severe pain).

### **Post-Surgical Rehabilitation**

Recovery program after surgery. Phases: acute (pain control, wound care), subacute (range of motion, strengthening), functional (return to activities). Protocols vary by procedure.

### **Post-Term Pregnancy**

Pregnancy continuing beyond 42 weeks gestation (294 days from LMP). Risk factors include prior post-term pregnancy, nulliparity, and genetic factors. Complications include macrosomia, oligohydramnios, meconium aspiration, placental insufficiency, and stillbirth.

### **Post-Test Probability**

The probability of disease after incorporating a test result with the pretest probability. It can be estimated using Bayes' theorem or by converting pretest odds to post-test odds with the appropriate likelihood ratio.

### **Post-Thrombotic Syndrome**

Chronic pain, heaviness, edema, skin change, and sometimes ulceration developing after deep-vein thrombosis because of persistent venous obstruction and valvular damage. Compression, exercise, skin care, and selected interventions may reduce disability.

### **Post-Transfusion Purpura**

A rare immune-mediated thrombocytopenic disorder occurring several days after transfusion of blood products, usually in previously sensitized individuals. It causes abrupt, severe thrombocytopenia

with petechiae, mucosal bleeding, or more serious haemorrhage.

### **Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder**

A disorder that may develop after exposure to actual or threatened death, serious injury, or sexual violence, causing persistent re-experiencing, avoidance, negative mood or cognition, and heightened arousal.

### **Post-Void Residual**

The amount of urine remaining in the bladder after urination, measured by ultrasound or catheterization. A persistently high residual may indicate incomplete emptying, but its significance depends on the volume, timing, symptoms, and clinical context.

### **Post-Void Residual Volume**

The amount of urine remaining in the bladder immediately after urination, measured by ultrasound or catheterization. An elevated residual suggests incomplete emptying but must be interpreted with timing, bladder volume, symptoms, and repeated measurements.

### **Postanesthesia Care Unit**

The postanesthesia care unit (PACU) is a monitored recovery area where patients are observed during the immediate postoperative period. Admission assessment includes vital signs, level of consciousness, pain assessment, and surgical site evaluation.

### **Postcholecystectomy Syndrome**

Persistence or recurrence of symptoms after cholecystectomy. Causes include retained common bile duct stones, sphincter of Oddi dysfunction, bile salt malabsorption, irritable bowel syndrome, and other gastrointestinal conditions. Evaluation includes liver function tests, MRCP, and endoscopic ultrasound.

### **Posterior Cruciate Ligament Injury**

Tear of the PCL, less common than ACL injury. Mechanism: dashboard injury (tibia striking dashboard), hyperflexion, or fall on a flexed knee with foot plantarflexed. Presents with posterior knee

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pain, mild swelling, and posterior sag of the tibia. Positive posterior drawer test (most sensitive), posterior sag sign (Godfrey test).

### **Posterior Cruciate Ligament Tear**

PCL tear: less common, usually from direct blow to tibia (dashboard injury). Symptoms: knee pain, swelling, instability. Diagnosis: posterior drawer test, MRI. Treatment: usually conservative, surgical if combined injuries.

### **Posterior Descending Artery**

An artery running in the posterior interventricular groove and supplying the inferior ventricular walls and posterior interventricular septum. It usually arises from the right coronary artery in right-dominant circulation but may arise from the circumflex artery.

### **Posterior Drawer Test**

PCL integrity test. Knee flexed 90 degrees, posterior tibial translation.

### **Posterior Pituitary**

The neural lobe of the pituitary that stores and releases vasopressin and oxytocin synthesized in the hypothalamus. Vasopressin regulates renal water retention and vascular tone; oxytocin contributes to uterine contraction and milk ejection.

### **Posterior Reversible Encephalopathy Syndrome**

A neurotoxic state caused by failed cerebrovascular autoregulation, typically from acute hypertension, eclampsia, immunosuppressive drugs (tacrolimus, cyclosporine), or sepsis. Presents with headache, seizures, altered consciousness, and visual disturbances.

### **Posterior Subcapsular Cataract**

A type of lens opacity located at the posterior aspect of the lens, just anterior to the posterior lens capsule, in the visual axis, and it is particularly visually disabling because of its central location.

### **Posterior Tibial Artery**

Arises from the popliteal artery, courses deep in the posterior leg, palpable behind the medial malleolus. Divides into medial/lateral plantar arteries for the sole. Supplies posterior leg muscles. Important for peripheral vascular disease assessment. The pedal pulse behind the medial malleolus is a key clinical examination component.

### **Posterior Urethral Valves**

The most common cause of lower urinary tract obstruction in male infants, caused by congenital mucosal folds (valves) in the posterior urethra (prostatic urethra) that obstruct urine outflow.

### **Posterior Uveitis**

Inflammation affecting the retina, choroid, or both. It may cause floaters, blurred vision, visual-field defects, or eye pain and can result from infection, autoimmune disease, or other inflammatory conditions.

### **Posterior Vitreous Detachment**

Separation of the posterior vitreous cortex from the retinal surface, commonly related to age-related vitreous liquefaction. New flashes or floaters require dilated retinal examination because an associated retinal tear or detachment may be present.

### **Postmenopausal Osteoporosis**

Bone loss caused by lower estrogen levels associated with menopause. Sometimes called type I osteoporosis.

### **Postmenopause**

The period in a woman's life lasting from the end of perimenopause until the end of life.

### **Postmortem Artifact**

Any structural, chemical, or physical change introduced into a body after death (e.g., embalming artifacts, insect activity, postmortem animal scavenging, resuscitation trauma) that mimics antemortem disease or trauma.

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### Postmortem Interval

Estimated elapsed time between actual death and the time of autopsy or body discovery, calculated utilizing algor mortis, livor mortis, rigor mortis, vitreous potassium levels, and insect succession patterns.

### Postmortem Toxicology

Toxicologic analysis of specimens collected after death to identify drugs, alcohols, poisons, and metabolites. Results must account for therapeutic administration, redistribution, decomposition, specimen site, contamination, and tolerance before conclusions about causation are made.

### Postnatal Depression

A depressive episode occurring after childbirth, with persistent low mood, anhedonia, sleep or appetite disturbance, guilt, impaired bonding, or suicidal thoughts.

### Postoperative Care

Structured post-surgical management encompassing pain control, fluid balance, wound care, early mobilization, and venous thromboembolism prophylaxis.

### Postoperative Cognitive Dysfunction

A decline in cognitive abilities such as memory, attention, or executive function after surgery. It may be temporary or persistent and is more frequent in older adults and after major or complicated procedures. Assessment requires comparison with the person's baseline and consideration of delirium, medication effects, and other medical causes.

### Postoperative Complications

Clavien-Dindo classification: Grade I (any deviation, no treatment), Grade II (pharmacologic), Grade III (surgical/endoscopic/radiologic intervention: IIIa no GA, IIIb GA), Grade IV (ICU: IVa single organ, IVb multi-organ), Grade V (death).

### Postoperative Delirium

A common complication after major surgery, particularly in elderly patients. It is categorized as hyperactive (agitation, restlessness, hallucinations),

hypoactive (lethargy, withdrawal, decreased responsiveness), or mixed. Hypoactive delirium is the most common and most missed form.

### Postoperative Ileus

Temporary impairment of gastrointestinal motility after surgery, most common after abdominal surgery. Pathophysiology: autonomic dysfunction (sympathetic overactivity), inflammatory mediators, opioids, and electrolyte abnormalities.

### Postoperative Nausea And Vomiting

Nausea, retching, or vomiting occurring after surgery. Risk is influenced by factors such as previous motion sickness or postoperative nausea, anesthetic technique, opioid use, and patient characteristics. Prevention and treatment are tailored to the individual risk and procedure.

### Postoperative Pain Management

Management of pain after surgery using a combination of medicines, regional techniques, physical measures, and rehabilitation. The plan is tailored to the procedure, pain severity, medical conditions, and risks of adverse effects.

### Postoperative Pulmonary Complication

Respiratory deterioration after surgery, including atelectasis, pneumonia, aspiration, respiratory failure, bronchospasm, and exacerbation of chronic lung disease. Risk reduction includes smoking cessation, lung-protective ventilation, analgesia, mobilization, and appropriate respiratory exercises.

### Postpartum Anxiety

Excessive, persistent, or distressing anxiety during pregnancy or after childbirth that interferes with sleep, daily function, bonding, or self-care. It may occur with panic, intrusive worries, or depression and deserves clinical assessment; thoughts of self-harm or harm to the baby require emergency help.

### Postpartum Blues

A common, short-lived period of tearfulness, mood changes, irritability, or anxiety beginning soon after childbirth and usually improving within two weeks.

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Support, rest, and practical help are important; persistent, severe, psychotic, or suicidal symptoms require prompt assessment for a postpartum mental-health disorder.

### **Postpartum Cardiomyopathy (Peripartum Cardiomyopathy)**

A dilated cardiomyopathy causing heart failure toward the end of pregnancy or during the months after delivery. Symptoms may include breathlessness, difficulty lying flat, swelling, fatigue, or chest discomfort and require prompt assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Peripartum Cardiomyopathy

### **Postpartum Endometritis**

Infection of the decidua and endometrial cavity after delivery, occurring more often after cesarean birth. Fever, uterine tenderness, pelvic pain, and foul-smelling lochia are typical; treatment generally requires intravenous broad-spectrum antibiotics.

### **Postpartum Hemorrhage**

Excessive bleeding after childbirth, usually caused by poor uterine contraction, retained placental tissue, genital-tract trauma, or a clotting disorder. It can cause shock and requires urgent obstetric assessment and treatment.

### **Postpartum Hemorrhage (Secondary)**

Excessive bleeding occurring between 24 hours and 12 weeks postpartum. Causes: retained products of conception (most common), endometritis, subinvolution of the placental site, and coagulopathy. Presents with heavy or prolonged bleeding, cramping, and passing clots. Diagnosis: ultrasound (retained tissue, thickened endometrium).

#### **Synonyms:**

Secondary

### **Postpartum Infection**

Infections occurring after delivery, a leading cause of maternal morbidity. Types: endometritis (most common, especially after cesarean), wound infection (cesarean incision, episiotomy, perineal laceration), urinary tract infection, mastitis, septic pelvic throm-

bophlebitis, and pneumonia.

### **Postpartum Psychosis**

A rare but severe psychiatric emergency (1-2 per 1000 deliveries) characterized by the acute onset of delusions, hallucinations, disorganized behavior, confusion, and mood swings (mania or depression) within 1-4 weeks postpartum.

### **Postpartum Thyroiditis**

Autoimmune inflammation of the thyroid occurring during the first year after delivery. It may cause a temporary hyperthyroid phase followed by hypothyroidism, and symptoms and recovery vary; thyroid-function testing guides follow-up and treatment.

### **Postrenal AKI**

Acute kidney injury caused by obstruction of urine flow from the kidneys to the urethra. Causes include prostate enlargement, stones, tumors, fibrosis, and neurogenic bladder. The effect depends on the location, duration, completeness, and whether one or both kidneys are affected.

### **Poststreptococcal Pustulosis**

A sterile, non-follicular pustular eruption occurring as a rare sequela of streptococcal pharyngitis, presenting with scattered pustules on an erythematous base, typically on the trunk and extremities. It is thought to be an immune-mediated hypersensitivity reaction to streptococcal antigens.

### **Postterm Pregnancy**

Pregnancy that continues beyond 42 completed weeks of gestation. Risks and management depend on gestational dating, fetal condition, and maternal health.

### **Posttraumatic Stress Disorder**

A psychiatric disorder that develops after exposure to a traumatic event (death, serious injury, sexual violence).

#### **Synonyms:**

PTSD (Posttraumatic Stress Disorder)



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### **Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome**

An autonomic disorder causing an excessive increase in heart rate after standing, with symptoms such as light-headedness, palpitations, fatigue, weakness, brain fog, nausea, or fainting. Diagnosis requires clinical assessment and exclusion of other causes of orthostatic symptoms.

### **Potassium Binders**

Sodium zirconium cyclosilicate and patiromer. Exchange potassium in GI tract for sodium or calcium. Treat chronic hyperkalemia allowing continued RAAS inhibitor use in CKD.

### **Potassium-Sparing Diuretics**

Potassium-sparing diuretics act on the distal nephron to promote sodium excretion while minimizing potassium loss. They include epithelial sodium channel blockers such as amiloride and triamterene, and mineralocorticoid receptor antagonists such as spironolactone and eplerenone.

### **Potency**

The amount of a drug required to produce a specified effect. A more potent drug produces that effect at a lower dose, but potency does not indicate the maximum effect.

### **Potency Vs Efficacy**

Potency is the amount of drug required to produce a given effect, measured by the EC<sub>50</sub> (the concentration producing 50% of maximal effect). Drugs with higher potency achieve effects at lower doses (e.g., fentanyl is more potent than morphine).

### **Pott Disease**

TB of the spine involving thoracic or lumbar vertebrae. Causes vertebral destruction, kyphosis (gibbus deformity), and paravertebral abscess. May cause spinal cord compression.

### **Potter Syndrome**

A sequence of anomalies resulting from severe oligohydramnios (low amniotic fluid volume), most commonly caused by bilateral renal agenesis, but also

from autosomal recessive polycystic kidney disease, posterior urethral valves, or chronic amniotic fluid leak.

### **Powassan Encephalitis**

Encephalitis caused by Powassan virus, a tick-borne flavivirus.

### **Prader-Willi Syndrome**

A genetic disorder caused by loss of function of genes on chromosome 15 (paternal deletion or maternal uniparental disomy). Features: neonatal hypotonia and failure to thrive, followed by hyperphagia and obesity in childhood. Intellectual disability, short stature, hypogonadism, and behavioral problems.

#### **Synonyms:**

Prader-Labhart-Willi Syndrome

### **Pralidoxime**

An oxime that can reactivate inhibited acetylcholinesterase when administered early after organophosphate poisoning, particularly for nicotinic weakness and respiratory-muscle dysfunction. It is used with atropine and supportive care according to exposure and local guidance.

### **Prebiotics**

Non-digestible fibers feeding beneficial gut bacteria. Sources: garlic, onions, leeks, asparagus, bananas, whole grains.

### **Prebiotics And Probiotics**

Prebiotics are nondigestible food ingredients (fiber and oligosaccharides—inulin, fructooligosaccharides, galactooligosaccharides) that selectively stimulate the growth and activity of beneficial gut bacteria (Bifidobacterium, Lactobacillus), promoting host health.

### **Precision Medicine**

Treatment tailored to individual tumor characteristics. Requires molecular profiling.

### **Preconception Counseling**

Counseling provided to women of reproductive age



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before pregnancy to optimize outcomes.

### **Prediabetes**

Blood glucose higher than normal but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes, usually identified by A1C, fasting glucose, or an oral glucose-tolerance test; it increases future diabetes and cardiovascular risk.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diabetes Pre (Prediabetes)

### **Predictive Test**

A test that estimates whether a person or disease is likely to respond to a particular treatment.

### **Preeclampsia**

Preeclampsia is pregnancy-related hypertension with proteinuria or other maternal organ dysfunction after midpregnancy and can progress to seizures, stroke, liver injury, or placental complications. pressure 140/90 mmHg or higher) after 20 weeks gestation with proteinuria or other end-organ damage.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pregnancy-Related Hypertension

### **Preeclampsia With Severe Features**

Preeclampsia accompanied by severe hypertension or signs of significant organ involvement, such as low platelets, liver or kidney dysfunction, pulmonary edema, severe headache, or visual symptoms. It requires urgent obstetric evaluation and management.

### **Pregnancy**

The physiological state in which a developing embryo or fetus grows within the female uterus, typically lasting approximately 40 weeks from the last menstrual period to childbirth.

### **Pregnancy Nutrition**

Nutrition care during pregnancy that supports maternal health, placental and fetal growth, and appropriate gestational weight gain. Energy, protein, folate, iron, iodine, choline, vitamin D, and other requirements vary by stage and individual clinical factors.

### **Pregnancy-Induced Hypertension**

New-onset hypertension during pregnancy without the proteinuria or organ dysfunction that defines preeclampsia. Diagnosis and treatment depend on repeated blood-pressure measurements, gestational age, symptoms, and evidence of maternal or fetal complications.

### **Preload**

The end-diastolic volume or pressure in the ventricles, representing the degree of ventricular stretch before contraction. Preload is determined by venous return and is estimated by the pulmonary capillary wedge pressure (PCWP) or left ventricular end-diastolic pressure (LVEDP).

### **Premature (Early) Ejaculation**

A persistent or recurrent pattern of ejaculation that occurs sooner than desired, with limited control and associated personal distress. Assessment considers the person's typical experience and sexual context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Early

### **Premature Atrial Contraction**

A premature beat arising from an ectopic focus in the atria, producing an early P wave (often abnormal morphology) followed by a normal QRS; common and usually benign, increasing with age and caffeine/stress. ECG: early abnormal P wave, normal PR and QRS, followed by a compensatory pause.

### **Premature Ovarian Insufficiency**

Loss of ovarian function before age forty characterized by amenorrhea, hypergonadotropic hypogonadism, and estrogen deficiency. Causes include genetic disorders particularly Turner syndrome and fragile X premutations, autoimmune oophoritis, iatrogenic from chemotherapy or radiation, and idiopathic.

### **Premature Rupture Of Membranes**

PROM: spontaneous rupture of the amniotic membranes before the onset of labor; preterm PROM (PPROM) occurs before 37 weeks. Features: gush

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or leakage of fluid per vaginam; confirmed by sterile speculum (pooling, ferning, nitrazine pH test) or amniotic fluid biomarkers (IGFBP-1, PAMG-1).

### **Premature Ventricular Contractions**

Ectopic beats originating from the ventricles, appearing as wide, bizarre QRS complexes that occur earlier than expected. PVCs are common in the general population and are usually benign. Frequent PVCs (>10% of total beats) may cause left ventricular dysfunction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Extrasystole (Premature Ventricular Contractions)  
PVC (Premature Ventricular Contractions)

### **Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder**

A severe, debilitating form of premenstrual syndrome characterized by marked mood symptoms (depression, anxiety, irritability, mood swings), physical symptoms (breast tenderness, bloating, fatigue), and functional impairment that occur during the luteal phase and remit within days of menses onset.

### **Premenstrual Syndrome**

A recurrent pattern of physical, emotional, and behavioral symptoms during the luteal phase of the menstrual cycle that resolve with menses. Affects up to 50% of reproductive-age women. Symptoms: irritability, mood swings, depression, anxiety, bloating, breast tenderness, fatigue, and appetite changes.

### **Prenatal Care**

Regular medical care during pregnancy to monitor maternal and fetal health. Includes history and physical exam, weight and blood pressure monitoring, urine testing, blood work, fundal height measurements, fetal heart rate auscultation, and ultrasound.

### **Prenatal Diagnosis**

Detection of genetic or structural disorders in fetus before birth. Methods: chorionic villus sampling (CVS, 10-13 weeks), amniocentesis (15-20 weeks), percutaneous umbilical blood sampling (PUBS, after 18 weeks). Non-invasive: NIPT (cell-free fetal DNA).

### **Prenatal Testing**

Screening and diagnostic tests performed during pregnancy to assess fetal health and development or identify genetic, chromosomal, and structural conditions. Tests may include ultrasound, maternal blood tests, cell-free DNA screening, chorionic-villus sampling, and amniocentesis.

### **Prenatal Exposure**

Contact of a fetus with a medicine, substance, infection, or environmental factor during pregnancy. Effects depend on the agent, dose, timing, and fetal susceptibility.

### **Prenatal Vitamins**

Multivitamin supplements formulated for pregnancy, containing folic acid (400-800 mcg), iron (27-60 mg), calcium (200-300 mg), vitamin D (400-600 IU), DHA (200 mg), and iodine (150-220 mcg). Started preconceptionally or at the first prenatal visit. Evidence supports NTD reduction from folic acid. Iron prevents maternal anemia.

### **Preoperative Assessment**

Preoperative assessment evaluates surgical risk and optimizes medical conditions before anesthesia. It includes medical history, physical examination, airway assessment, cardiovascular risk stratification ( Revised Cardiac Risk Index ), pulmonary function assessment, and laboratory testing based on clinical indication.

### **Preoperative Evaluation**

Medical assessment before elective surgery to optimize outcomes and minimize perioperative risk.

### **Prerenal Azotemia**

A rise in nitrogen-containing waste products caused by reduced effective blood flow to the kidneys without primary renal-tissue injury. Causes include dehydration, hemorrhage, heart failure, sepsis, and hepatorenal syndrome; urine indices may support but do not by themselves establish the diagnosis.

### **Presbycusis**

Bilateral, usually symmetric age-related sensorineu-

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ral hearing loss, initially affecting high frequencies and speech discrimination in noise. Management includes hearing rehabilitation, hearing aids, communication strategies, and cochlear implantation in selected severe cases.

### **Prescription Drug**

A medication whose dispensing or use is subject to prescription requirements under the applicable law. It requires professional oversight because of its risks, complexity, or need for monitoring; regulatory approval and prescribing rules vary by country and product.

### **Prescription Medications**

Pharmaceutical drugs that require authorization from a licensed healthcare provider before they can be dispensed to a patient. These medications are regulated because they carry risks that necessitate professional oversight, including potential side effects, drug interactions, and the need for precise dosing.

### **Preseptal Cellulitis**

Preseptal cellulitis, also known as periorbital cellulitis, is an infection of the eyelid and periorbital tissues anterior to the orbital septum, without involvement of the orbital contents, and it is the most common orbital infection, particularly in children.

#### **Synonyms:**

periorbital cellulitis, is an infection of the.

### **Pressure Atrophy**

The gradual wasting of tissue resulting from sustained external compression that impairs blood supply and causes cellular shrinkage and eventual death. The mechanism involves compression of blood vessels, which reduces perfusion and causes ischemia of the dependent tissue.

### **Pressure Injury**

Localized damage to the skin and/or underlying soft tissue caused by prolonged pressure, shear, or friction, most commonly over bony prominences.

### **Pressure Support Ventilation**

Spontaneous breathing mode with ventilator-provided pressure support above PEEP for each breath. Reduces work of breathing. Used for weaning from mechanical ventilation.

### **Pressure Ulcer**

Localized damage to skin and underlying tissue caused by sustained pressure or pressure with shear, typically over a bony prominence. Staging includes non-blanchable erythema, partial-thickness loss, full-thickness loss, and full-thickness tissue loss with exposed or palpable deep structures; obscured wounds are unstageable.

### **Pressure Ulcer Prevention**

Measures that reduce prolonged pressure and tissue injury, including repositioning, support surfaces, skin inspection, moisture control, nutrition, and mobility.

### **Pressure Urticaria**

A form of chronic inducible urticaria in which sustained pressure causes localized swelling, erythema, and pain, usually after a delay of several hours. Lesions may last 8 to 72 hours and commonly affect the hands, feet, buttocks, or areas compressed by clothing or sitting.

### **Pressure-Flow Study**

Suite of diagnostic procedures designed to evaluate the physiological function of the lower urinary tract (bladder and urethral sphincter) during filling, storage, and emptying phases. See urodynamic testing.

### **Presyncope**

The sensation of imminent fainting (lightheadedness, weakness, visual blurring) without actual loss of consciousness, due to transient global cerebral hypoperfusion that resolves before LOC. Causes: orthostatic hypotension (volume depletion, autonomic failure, medications), vasovagal, cardiac (arrhythmias, aortic stenosis), and metabolic.

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### **Preterm Birth**

Birth before 37 completed weeks of gestation. It may follow spontaneous labor or rupture of the membranes, or may be medically indicated because of maternal or fetal complications.

### **Preterm Infant**

An infant born before 37 completed weeks of gestation; classified by gestational age (late preterm 34-36, moderate 32-33, very preterm <32, extremely <28 weeks) and by birth weight. Causes: preterm labor, PPROM, preeclampsia, multiple pregnancy, infection, and iatrogenic.

### **Preterm Labor**

Regular uterine contractions causing cervical change before 37 weeks gestation. Risk factors include prior preterm delivery, multiple gestation, infection, and cervical insufficiency. Diagnosis requires regular contractions with documented cervical change.

### **Preterm Premature Rupture Of Membranes**

Rupture of the amniotic membranes before the onset of labor at <37 weeks gestation. Causes: infection (subclinical chorioamnionitis), cervical insufficiency, and prior PPROM. Presents with sudden gush or leakage of fluid per vagina.

### **Pretest Probability**

The estimated probability that a patient has a disease before the result of a diagnostic test is known. It is based on prevalence, symptoms, examination findings, risk factors, and prior test results and should guide test selection and interpretation.

### **Pretibial Myxedema**

Localized dermatopathy occurring in approximately five percent of patients with Graves disease caused by glycosaminoglycan deposition in the dermis particularly over the pretibial area. Presents as non-pitting indurated plaques with a peau d'orange appearance.

### **Preventive Dentistry**

Practice of preventing dental disease. Methods: oral

hygiene instruction, fluoride, sealants, diet counseling, regular check-ups.

### **Prevertebral Air**

Gas in the prevertebral soft tissues on lateral cervical spine radiograph, indicating a breach in the aerodigestive tract. It may result from esophageal perforation, tracheal injury, retropharyngeal abscess with gas-forming organisms, or trauma.

### **Primary Adrenal Insufficiency (Addison's Disease)**

Destruction or dysfunction of the adrenal cortex causing deficiency of cortisol and aldosterone, presenting with fatigue, hyperpigmentation, weight loss, and salt craving. Lifelong hormone replacement is required.

#### **Synonyms:**

Addison's disease

### **Primary Adrenal Lymphoma**

A rare lymphoma arising primarily in the adrenal gland, most commonly diffuse large B-cell lymphoma. It often presents bilaterally and may cause adrenal insufficiency.

### **Primary Aldosteronism**

Excess production of aldosterone by the adrenal glands, usually from an adrenal nodule or enlargement of both glands. It increases sodium retention and may cause hypertension, low potassium, or suppressed renin.

### **Primary Biliary Cholangitis**

A chronic autoimmune liver disease in which small intrahepatic bile ducts are progressively damaged. It can cause cholestasis, itching, fatigue, and eventually cirrhosis; antimitochondrial antibodies often support the diagnosis.

### **Primary Ciliary Dyskinesia**

An inherited disorder of ciliary structure or function that impairs mucociliary clearance. It can cause chronic sinus and lung infections, bronchiectasis, infertility, and abnormal organ laterality.

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### Primary Hyperaldosteronism

Excess autonomous production of aldosterone by the adrenal glands. It can cause hypertension, low potassium, metabolic alkalosis, and suppressed renin. Causes include an adrenal adenoma or bilateral adrenal hyperplasia.

### Primary Hyperoxaluria

A group of autosomal recessive metabolic disorders characterized by overproduction of oxalate by the liver, leading to calcium oxalate deposition in the kidneys and other organs. Type 1 is caused by alanine-glyoxylate aminotransferase deficiency. It presents with recurrent nephrolithiasis, nephrocalcinosis, and progressive renal failure.

### Primary Hyperparathyroidism

Autonomous overproduction of parathyroid hormone from one or more abnormal parathyroid glands causing hypercalcemia. Most commonly caused by a single parathyroid adenoma accounting for approximately eighty-five percent. Multigland hyperplasia accounts for approximately ten to fifteen percent and parathyroid carcinoma is rare.

### Primary Hypertrophic Osteoarthropathy

A rare inherited syndrome characterized by digital clubbing, periostosis of long bones, and pachydermia, presenting with joint pain, skin thickening, and visible nail-bed enlargement.

### Primary Immune Response

The adaptive immune response to first exposure to an antigen, characterized by a slow onset (lag phase: days, during which antigen processing, clonal expansion, and differentiation occur), followed by rising antibody titers (predominantly IgM, then IgG), and generation of memory cells.

### Primary Immunodeficiency

A group of genetically determined disorders of the immune system causing increased susceptibility to infection, autoimmunity, and malignancy.

### Primary Lateral Sclerosis

A rare neurodegenerative disorder confined to the

upper motor neurons (corticospinal tract) of the motor cortex and brainstem. Presents with slowly progressive spasticity, hyperreflexia, Babinski sign, and pseudobulbar affect (emotional lability).

### Primary Metabolism

The essential biochemical processes by which cells produce energy, synthesize molecules, and maintain their functions.

### Primary Myelofibrosis

A chronic myeloproliferative neoplasm characterized by bone marrow fibrosis (reticulin and/or collagen fibrosis), extramedullary hematopoiesis (primarily splenic and hepatic), and a leukoerythroblastic peripheral blood picture.

### Primary Open-Angle Glaucoma

A chronic optic neuropathy with characteristic retinal ganglion-cell and optic-nerve loss, usually accompanied by progressive visual-field defects, despite an anatomically open anterior-chamber angle. Intraocular pressure is an important modifiable risk factor, and treatment lowers pressure to slow progression.

### Primary Ovarian Insufficiency

Loss of normal ovarian activity before age 40, characterized by irregular or absent menses, reduced estrogen, and intermittently or persistently elevated gonadotropins. Causes include genetic, autoimmune, iatrogenic, toxic, infectious, and unknown factors.

### Primary Prevention

Preventing cancer development. Strategies: smoking cessation, vaccination (HPV, hepatitis B), sun protection, healthy diet, exercise.

### Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis

Chronic cholestatic liver disease characterized by progressive fibrosis and strictures of intrahepatic and extrahepatic bile ducts. The disease has a strong association with inflammatory bowel disease, especially ulcerative colitis, occurring in a substantial proportion of patients.



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## Primary Tuberculosis

The first infection with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*. It may produce a small pulmonary focus and regional lymph-node involvement; the infection may be contained as latent tuberculosis or progress to active disease.

## Primary Tumor

Original cancer site. Secondary: metastatic sites.

## Primordial Prevention

Preventing the emergence of disease risk factors by addressing social, economic, behavioural, and environmental conditions early. Examples: promoting healthy diets and physical activity in children, reducing tobacco exposure, and creating safe environments for exercise.

## Prion Disease

A neurodegenerative disease caused by abnormal folding and propagation of prion protein. These disorders are rare and usually progressive and fatal, although their course varies by the specific disease.

## PRK

Photorefractive keratectomy, commonly known as PRK, is a refractive surgical procedure that corrects myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism by reshaping the corneal stroma using an excimer laser after mechanical removal of the corneal epithelium, without creating a corneal flap.

## Probable Cause

A legally recognized reasonable basis for believing that a person committed an offense or that evidence of an offense will be found.

## Probe

Instrument for exploring wound or cavity.

## Probiotic

Live microorganisms administered in adequate amounts to confer a health benefit by modulating the microbiome and immune responses.

## Procalcitonin

A biomarker that may rise during some bacterial infections and systemic inflammation. It can support assessment of infection and antibiotic decisions, but it cannot by itself diagnose or exclude bacterial infection or determine sepsis severity.

## Procalcitonin-Guided Antibiotic Therapy

The use of procalcitonin levels to guide initiation and discontinuation of antibiotics. Procalcitonin is a biomarker that rises in bacterial infections and falls with effective treatment. Elevated levels support the need for antibiotic therapy, while declining levels support discontinuation.

## Procedural Sedation

Administration of sedative and analgesic medicines to facilitate a painful or anxiety-provoking procedure while preserving spontaneous ventilation and protective reflexes to the intended depth. Continuous monitoring and immediate rescue capability are required.

## Procedure

A planned medical or surgical action performed for diagnosis, treatment, prevention, or palliation.

## Prodrug

A prodrug is a pharmacologically inactive compound that is converted to an active drug through metabolic processes within the body. Prodrugs are designed to overcome limitations of the parent drug including poor bioavailability, rapid metabolism, lack of tissue selectivity, or unacceptable side effects.

## Product Liability

Legal responsibility for injury or damage caused by a defective or unsafe product.

## Progesterone Supplementation

Administration of progesterone to prevent preterm birth in high-risk women. Natural progesterone (17-alpha hydroxyprogesterone caproate) shown to reduce preterm birth rate in women with prior spontaneous preterm delivery. Also beneficial for short



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cervix detected on screening. Typically started in the second trimester.

### **Prognostic Test**

A test that provides information about the likely course or outcome of a disease.

### **Progression**

Worsening or advancement of a disease, such as increasing tumor size, new lesions, or spread to another site.

### **Progression-Free Survival**

The length of time from a defined starting point, such as diagnosis or treatment, until cancer progression or death from any cause, whichever occurs first.

### **Progressive Disease**

Worsening of cancer during or after treatment, defined per RECIST as growth of target lesions, appearance of new lesions, or unequivocal progression of non-target lesions.

### **Progressive Supranuclear Palsy**

A neurodegenerative tauopathy characterized by the accumulation of tau protein in the basal ganglia, brainstem, and cerebral cortex, belonging to the family of Parkinson plus syndromes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Steele-Richardson-Olszewski Syndrome Supranuclear Palsy

### **Prolactin Physiology**

Prolactin is the only pituitary hormone primarily under tonic inhibitory control by the hypothalamus through dopamine acting on D2 receptors. Prolactin stimulates lactation suppresses GnRH and is important for reproductive function. Physiological elevations occur during pregnancy lactation breast stimulation sleep and stress.

### **Prolactinoma Treatment**

Treatment may include a dopamine agonist, surgery, radiation, or observation, depending on tumor size,

symptoms, hormone levels, treatment response, and patient preferences. Dopamine agonists often lower prolactin levels and reduce tumor size.

### **Prolapse Of Orbital Fat**

Herniation of intraorbital fat through a dehiscence in the orbital septum, most commonly presenting as a painless, soft, reducible mass in the upper eyelid or lower eyelid. It is often age-related and may be confused with a lipoma or dermoid cyst.

### **Prolapse Of The Uterus (Uterine Prolapse)**

Descent of the uterus into the vaginal canal due to weakening of pelvic floor supports, most commonly the uterosacral and cardinal ligaments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Uterine Prolapse

### **Proliferative Diabetic Retinopathy**

The advanced stage of diabetic retinopathy, characterized by the growth of new, fragile blood vessels (neovascularization) on the retinal surface, optic disc, or iris in response to severe retinal ischemia and the release of vascular endothelial growth factor.

### **Prolonged Deceleration**

A fetal heart rate deceleration lasting  $\geq 2$  minutes but  $<10$  minutes. If the deceleration persists  $\geq 10$  minutes, it is a baseline change. Causes: maternal hypotension (epidural-induced aortocaval compression), uterine hyperstimulation, umbilical cord prolapse, placental abruption, and maternal seizure.

### **Prolonged Second Stage**

Second stage of labor exceeding the time limits: nulliparas — 3 hours with regional anesthesia (2 hours without); multiparas — 2 hours with regional (1 hour without). Management: reassess position, contractions, and fetal status. For inadequate contractions: oxytocin augmentation. For malposition (OP, OT): manual rotation.

### **Prominent Iris Collarette**

A visible thickening or ridge of the iris at the junction of the pupillary and ciliary zones, representing

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the site where the embryonic pupillary membrane was attached. It is typically a normal anatomical variant but can be a clinical sign in conditions such as Axenfeld-Rieger syndrome or iridocorneal endothelial syndrome.

### Promoter

DNA sequence upstream of gene where RNA polymerase and transcription factors bind to initiate transcription. Core promoter: TATA box, transcription start site. Regulatory elements: enhancers, silencers.

### Prone Positioning

Turning supine patients to prone for > 12 hours daily in severe ARDS. Improves oxygenation by recruiting dorsal lung segments. Reduces mortality when  $\text{PaO}_2/\text{FiO}_2 < 150$ .

### Propafenone

A class IC antiarrhythmic with sodium channel blockade and weak beta-blocking activity. Used for paroxysmal atrial fibrillation (in patients without structural heart disease, including 'pill-in-the-pocket'), supraventricular tachycardias, and ventricular arrhythmias.

### Properdin Deficiency

X-linked recessive (CFP gene). Properdin stabilizes alternative pathway C3 convertase. Recurrent Neisseria infections (meningococcemia, gonococcemia). Low AH50, normal CH50, low properdin. Treatment: meningococcal vaccination (ACWY + B), prophylactic penicillin, IVIG for severe infections.

### Propofol Infusion Syndrome

Rare but fatal complication of prolonged high-dose propofol infusion. Features: metabolic acidosis, rhabdomyolysis, cardiac failure, hyperlipidemia. Risk: critical illness, children, high doses (>4-5 mg/kg/hr), prolonged infusion (>48 hours). Prevention: limit dose and duration.

### Prostacyclin Analogs

Medications that mimic prostacyclin (PGI<sub>2</sub>), causing vasodilation and inhibiting platelet aggrega-

tion in the pulmonary vasculature. They include epoprostenol (continuous IV), treprostinil (subcutaneous, IV, inhaled, oral), and iloprost (inhaled). They are used for severe PAH.

### Prostaglandin Analogs

A class of topical medications used in the treatment of open-angle glaucoma and ocular hypertension that lower intraocular pressure by increasing the uveoscleral outflow of aqueous humor, reducing intraocular pressure by approximately twenty-five to thirty-five percent.

### Prostate Adenocarcinoma

The most common non-cutaneous malignancy in men and the second leading cause of cancer death in men after lung cancer. The disease typically arises in the peripheral zone of the prostate and is hormone-dependent, requiring androgens for growth.

### Prostate Biopsy

Sampling of prostate tissue, commonly by transperineal or transrectal needle technique, for histologic diagnosis of prostate cancer. Targeted and systematic cores may be combined, with attention to infection prevention, bleeding, urinary retention, and sepsis risk.

### Prostate Cancer

Most common non-cutaneous cancer in men. Risk factors: age, family history, African American race, high red meat intake. Screening: PSA testing, DRE. Diagnosis: transrectal ultrasound-guided biopsy. Staging: TNM system, Gleason score.

#### Synonyms:

Cancer, Prostate Prostatic Carcinoma (Prostate Cancer)

### Prostate-Specific Antigen

A serine protease produced mainly by prostate epithelial cells and secreted into seminal fluid. PSA can be measured in blood, where levels may rise with benign enlargement, inflammation, infection, or prostate cancer. Interpretation depends on age, prostate size, medicines, symptoms, and changes over time.

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## Prosthetic Limb

Artificial replacement for missing limb. Types: above/below knee, above/below elbow. Components: socket, suspension, joint, pylon, terminal device. Materials: carbon fiber, silicone, metal. Rehabilitation: gait training, strength, ADL.

## Prosthetic Training

Training for amputees: stump care, donning/doffing, gait training, balance, stair negotiation, community ambulation.

## Prosthetics

Artificial replacement of missing body part. Elderly use: lower limb (transtibial, transfemoral), upper limb. Considerations: mobility level, cognition, vision, comorbidities, support system. Rehabilitation: physical therapy, strength training, balance.

## Prosthodontics

Dental specialty concerned with replacement of missing teeth and restoration of oral function. Types: fixed (crowns, bridges, implants), removable (partial dentures, complete dentures), maxillofacial prosthetics (ocular, nasal, auricular). Goals: aesthetics, function, phonetics, preservation of remaining structures.

## Protease Inhibitor

A class of antiretroviral drugs that block the viral protease enzyme responsible for cleaving polypeptide precursors into functional proteins during HIV replication, preventing the formation of mature, infectious virions. Used in combination antiretroviral therapy for HIV infection.

## Protease Inhibitors

A class of antiviral drugs that block viral proteases, enzymes essential for processing viral polyproteins into functional components needed for viral assembly and maturation.

## Protective Factor

Attribute decreasing probability of disease. Examples: exercise (cardiovascular disease), vaccination (infectious disease).

## Protein Binding

The reversible association of drug molecules with plasma proteins, primarily albumin for acidic drugs and alpha-1 acid glycoprotein for basic drugs. Only unbound or free drug is pharmacologically active and available for distribution to tissues, metabolism by the liver, and excretion by the kidneys.

## Protein C

Natural anticoagulant. Inactivates factors Va and VIIIa. Warfarin can cause skin necrosis in deficiency.

## Protein C Deficiency

An inherited (autosomal dominant) thrombophilia causing increased VTE risk. Protein C is a vitamin K-dependent natural anticoagulant that inactivates factors Va and VIIIa and stimulates fibrinolysis. Heterozygous: 6-10 fold increased VTE risk.

## Protein Folding

The process by which newly synthesized polypeptide chains acquire their functional three-dimensional structures. The amino acid sequence (primary structure) determines the folding pathway.

## Protein S

Vitamin K-dependent plasma glycoprotein that acts as a cofactor for activated protein C in the inactivation of factors Va and VIIIa. Deficiency or dysfunction increases the risk of venous thromboembolism.

## Protein S Deficiency

An inherited (autosomal dominant) thrombophilia. Protein S is a vitamin K-dependent natural anticoagulant that acts as a cofactor for activated protein C in inactivating factors Va and VIIIa. Heterozygous: 2-10 fold increased VTE risk. Homozygous: rare, purpura fulminans.

## Protein Synthesis

Translation of mRNA code into polypeptide chain. Initiation: ribosome assembly at start codon (AUG). Elongation: aminoacyl-tRNAs bring amino acids; peptide bonds form in peptidyl transferase center; ribosome translocates. Termination: stop codon (UAA, UAG, UGA) recognized by release factors.

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## Protein-Energy Malnutrition

Severe deficiency of protein and calories. Types: marasmus (chronic, wasting), kwashiorkor (acute, edema, fatty liver), marasmic-kwashiorkor. Risk: famine, poverty, alcoholism, malignancy, malabsorption. Treatment: gradual refeeding, monitor refeeding syndrome.

## Proto-Oncogene

A normal gene that regulates cell growth, division, differentiation, or survival and can become an oncogene after activating mutation, amplification, translocation, or overexpression.

## Proton Pump Inhibitor

A class of medications that irreversibly inhibit the gastric H<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup> ATPase (proton pump) in parietal cells, the final common pathway of gastric acid secretion, producing profound and sustained suppression of both basal and stimulated acid production.

## Proton Therapy

Radiation using protons instead of photons. Bragg peak allows precise dose delivery. Used for pediatric tumors, skull base tumors.

## Proximal Humerus Fractures

Proximal humerus fractures: Neer classification (4 parts: articular surface, greater tuberosity, lesser tuberosity, shaft; displaced >1 cm or angulated >45 degrees = part). 1-part (nondisplaced): sling, early motion. 2-part: surgical neck (ORIF plate, IM nail) or greater tuberosity (if displaced >5mm or rotator cuff involvement).

## Proximal Radioulnar Joint

Pivot synovial joint between radial head circumference and ulnar radial notch, held by the annular ligament. Allows pronation/supination with approximately 150 degrees range. Parallel bones in supination; radius crosses ulna in pronation. Significant in radial head fractures, Monteggia fracture-dislocations, and nursemaid's elbow.

## Proximal Tubule

Segment of the nephron extending from Bowman

capsule to the loop of Henle with a convoluted proximal straight tubule and convoluted proximal tubule. Responsible for reabsorbing approximately sixty-five percent of filtered sodium, water, bicarbonate, glucose, amino acids, and phosphate through an extensive brush border.

## Proximal Tubule Reabsorption

The proximal convoluted tubule (PCT) reabsorbs approximately 65 percent of filtered sodium, water, glucose, amino acids, bicarbonate, and phosphate.

## Proximate Cause

The legally sufficient cause that directly contributes to an injury or outcome.

## Prune Belly Syndrome

A congenital syndrome comprising the triad: deficient abdominal wall musculature (wrinkled, prune-like appearance), bilateral cryptorchidism (undescended testes), and urinary tract anomalies (dilated ureters, dilated and trabeculated bladder, and posterior urethral valves or urethral atresia). Almost exclusively affects boys.

## Pruritus Ani

Persistent itching around the anus with multiple potential causes including hemorrhoids, fissures, infections such as pinworms and candidiasis, dermatologic conditions including psoriasis and lichen sclerosis, and idiopathic causes.

## Pruritus In CKD

Severe itching in dialysis patients from uremic toxin accumulation, elevated calcium-phosphorus product, and secondary hyperparathyroidism. Difficult to treat. Include phosphate binders, dialysis optimization, gabapentin, and UV phototherapy.

## PSA (Prostate-Specific Antigen)

A serine protease produced by prostate tissue and measured in blood. It may be used with shared decision-making to assess prostate-cancer risk and to monitor known disease. PSA can also rise with benign enlargement, inflammation, infection, or recent procedures, so no single value establishes or

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excludes cancer.

**Synonyms:**

Prostate-Specific Antigen

**Pseudoaneurysm**

A contained arterial wall disruption in which blood communicates with the arterial lumen but is held by surrounding tissue rather than all layers of the arterial wall. It may follow catheterization, trauma, surgery, infection, or grafting and can rupture or embolize.

**Pseudobulbar Affect**

Involuntary episodes of laughing or crying disproportionate to mood, usually due to neurologic disease.

**Synonyms:**

Pathological Laughter And Crying PBA

**Pseudoclubbing**

Broadening and flattening of the nail tips without the complete loss of the angle between the nail and nail fold that characterizes true clubbing. It is seen in conditions such as hyperparathyroidism, rheumatoid arthritis, and psoriasis.

**Pseudoephedrine**

A sympathomimetic (alpha-1 agonist, some beta effects) oral decongestant used for nasal congestion in colds and sinusitis. Increases nasal mucosal vasoconstriction.

**Pseudogout**

Calcium pyrophosphate deposition disease (CPPD): deposition of calcium pyrophosphate dihydrate crystals in joints, causing acute arthritis resembling gout (pseudogout) or chronic osteoarthritis-like disease.

**Synonyms:**

Arthritis Pseudogout (Pseudogout)

**Pseudogout Flare**

Acute crystal-induced arthritis caused by calcium pyrophosphate dihydrate deposition, often affecting the knee or wrist. Identification of positively birefringent rhomboid crystals in synovial fluid supports the diagnosis.

**Pseudohypoparathyroidism**

A group of disorders in which target tissues resist parathyroid hormone, causing low calcium, high phosphate, and elevated PTH, sometimes with characteristic skeletal features or hormone resistance.

**Pseudomelanosis Duodeni**

Benign condition characterized by dark pigment deposits in the duodenal mucosa, visible as slate-gray or black patches on endoscopy, caused by accumulation of iron-containing pigment in macrophages within the lamina propria.

**Pseudomembranous Colitis**

Colonic inflammation caused by *C. difficile* infection showing yellow-white plaques on colonoscopy. The plaques consist of fibrin, inflammatory cells, and necrotic epithelial debris overlying mucosal ulceration. Presents with profuse watery diarrhea and abdominal pain.

**Synonyms:**

*C. Difficile* Colitis Colitis, Pseudomembranous

**Pseudomonas Aeruginosa Infection**

Infection caused by *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, an opportunistic gram-negative bacterium that can affect the lungs, wounds, urinary tract, blood, or other sites.

**Pseudomonas Aeruginosa Resistance**

*Pseudomonas aeruginosa* has intrinsic and acquired resistance mechanisms making it inherently resistant to many antibiotics. Intrinsic resistance includes low outer membrane permeability, efflux pumps, and chromosomal beta-lactamase.

**Pseudomyxoma Peritonei**

Accumulation of mucinous ascites and mucin-producing tumor nodules in the peritoneal cavity, usually from a ruptured low-grade appendiceal or ovarian mucinous neoplasm; treated with cytoreductive surgery and hyperthermic intraperitoneal chemotherapy.

**Pseudothrombocytosis Due To Red Cell**



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## **Fragments**

Falsely elevated platelet count on automated hematology analyzers caused by fragmentation of red blood cells (schistocytes) being counted as platelets. Seen in microangiopathic hemolytic anemias such as TTP, HUS, DIC, and mechanical heart valves. Manual peripheral blood smear review confirms true platelet count.

## **PSMA**

Prostate-specific membrane antigen. Target for PET imaging and therapy in prostate cancer.

## **Psoas Abscess**

A collection of pus in or around the psoas muscle, caused by infection spreading through the blood or from nearby tissues. It may cause back or hip pain, fever, difficulty walking, or few symptoms and usually requires imaging and targeted treatment.

## **Psoriatic Arthritis**

An inflammatory arthritis associated with psoriasis of the skin or nails. It may affect the spine, peripheral joints, digits, or tendon insertions, and diagnosis uses the clinical pattern together with appropriate laboratory and imaging findings.

### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis Psoriatic (Psoriatic Arthritis)

## **Psychoactive Substance**

A substance that alters mood, perception, cognition, behavior, or consciousness.

## **Psychodermatology**

Psychodermatology addresses the mind-skin connection. Stress exacerbates psoriasis, eczema, acne, and urticaria. Psychiatric disorders (depression, anxiety, body dysmorphic disorder) are associated with skin conditions.

## **Psychodynamic Therapy**

A form of depth psychology that explores how unconscious processes, early life experiences, and internal conflicts influence current thoughts, feelings, and behaviors. It involves exploration of transference

and countertransference, defense mechanisms, and the therapeutic relationship as a vehicle for change.

## **Psychogenic Non-Epileptic Seizures**

Seizure-like episodes that are not caused by abnormal electrical activity in the brain. They are a form of conversion disorder with attacks or seizures. Events may include shaking, stiffening, unresponsiveness, and other movements.

## **Psychological Support**

Counseling, therapy for patients with chronic illness, disability, pain. Address depression, anxiety, adjustment difficulties, coping strategies.

## **Psychosocial Rehabilitation**

Support for mental illness recovery: skills training, supported employment, peer support.

## **Psychosocial Support**

Cancer affects mental health. Depression, anxiety common. Support groups, counseling beneficial.

## **PTH-Related Peptide**

A peptide that activates the parathyroid-hormone receptor and can cause humoral hypercalcemia of malignancy. It increases bone resorption and renal calcium retention while reducing phosphate reabsorption.

## **Pthirus Pubis**

The pubic louse, a parasitic insect that infests the pubic hair and occasionally other coarse body hair, causing pediculosis pubis. Transmission is primarily through sexual contact. It causes intense pruritus and may transmit *Borrelia recurrentis* causing relapsing fever. Diagnosis is by visual identification of the louse or nits.

## **PTSD**

Post-traumatic stress disorder, a condition involving persistent trauma-related memories, avoidance, negative mood or cognition, and heightened arousal after a severe traumatic event.



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## Public Exposure

Radiation exposure to public from nuclear medicine patients. Guidelines for discharge after therapy. I-131 therapy: radiation safety instructions for 3-7 days.

## Public Health

The science and practice of protecting and improving the health of communities through education, policy-making, and research for disease and injury prevention.

## Public Health Emergency

Event threatening public health. Examples: pandemic, bioterrorism, natural disaster. Declaration enables special powers.

## Public Health Research Bias

Systematic error in a population-health study, including selection bias, information bias, and confounding.

## Pudendal Block

A local anesthetic block of the pudendal nerve (S2-S4) used for perineal anesthesia during the second stage of labor, outlet forceps delivery, or perineal repair. Technique: transvaginal approach — a needle guide is placed on the ischial spine, and the needle is advanced through the sacrospinous ligament.

## Puerperal Psychosis

A rare psychiatric emergency beginning soon after childbirth, characterized by rapidly changing mood, confusion, delusions, hallucinations, or disorganized behavior.

## Pugilistic Stance

The characteristic body position adopted by fire victims—flexed arms, elbows bent, fists clenched, knees flexed—resulting from heat-induced contraction (denaturation) of muscles (mainly flexors) and tendons, not from conscious movement. It occurs with thermal injury and can be present regardless of cause (even if death preceded fire).

## Pulmonary Alveolar Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the alveolar spaces from disruption of the alveolar-capillary membrane. Causes include vasculitis (GPA, MPA, Goodpasture), connective tissue disease, medications, and coagulopathy. It presents with hemoptysis, falling hemoglobin, diffuse bilateral infiltrates, and serially bloody returns on BAL.

## Pulmonary Alveolar Microlithiasis

A rare genetic disease caused by SLC34A2 mutations, leading to accumulation of calcium phosphate microliths within the alveoli. HRCT shows diffuse bilateral calcified nodules with a “sandstorm” appearance. It is usually diagnosed in the third to fourth decade.

## Pulmonary Alveolar Proteinosis

A rare disease characterized by accumulation of surfactant-like material within the alveoli due to impaired clearance by alveolar macrophages. Most cases are autoimmune (anti-GM-CSF antibodies). Presents with progressive dyspnea and cough. HRCT shows bilateral ground-glass opacities with “crazy paving” pattern.

## Pulmonary Angiography

Contrast imaging of the pulmonary arteries, usually by catheter. It can diagnose pulmonary vascular abnormalities but is now used less often for pulmonary embolism because CT pulmonary angiography is less invasive.

## Pulmonary Arterial Hypertension

A precapillary pulmonary hypertension syndrome caused by increased pulmonary vascular resistance from pulmonary arteriolar disease. It may be idiopathic, heritable, drug-associated, or associated with conditions such as connective-tissue disease, congenital heart disease, portal hypertension, or HIV.

## Pulmonary Arteriovenous Fistula

An abnormal direct connection between a pulmonary artery and vein that bypasses the capillary bed. It can cause hypoxemia, cyanosis, dyspnea,

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paradoxical emboli, or brain abscess.

### **Pulmonary Arteriovenous Malformation**

An abnormal direct communication between a pulmonary artery and vein, causing a right-to-left shunt. It may be idiopathic or associated with hereditary hemorrhagic telangiectasia (Osler-Weber-Rendu syndrome). It can cause hypoxemia, paradoxical emboli (stroke, brain abscess), and hemoptysis.

### **Pulmonary Artery Catheter**

A catheter inserted through the right heart into the pulmonary artery to measure hemodynamic parameters (PA pressure, PAWP, cardiac output). Used for diagnosis and management of pulmonary hypertension, heart failure, and critical illness.

### **Pulmonary Atresia**

A congenital heart defect where the pulmonary valve is completely absent (atretic), obstructing right ventricular outflow. Two main types: pulmonary atresia with intact ventricular septum (PA-IVS) and pulmonary atresia with ventricular septal defect (PA-VSD, also called tetralogy of Fallot with pulmonary atresia).

#### **Synonyms:**

tetralogy of Fallot with pulmonary atresia).

### **Pulmonary Capillary Wedge Pressure**

An indirect estimate of left-atrial pressure obtained by briefly occluding a small pulmonary-artery branch with a balloon-tipped catheter. It reflects left-sided filling pressure when measured correctly and interpreted in the appropriate clinical and ventilatory context.

### **Pulmonary Contusion**

Bruising of the lung parenchyma from blunt chest trauma, causing hemorrhage and edema without lung laceration. It impairs gas exchange and can progress to ARDS. It is often associated with rib fractures and flail chest. Treatment is supportive with lung-protective ventilation.

### **Pulmonary Edema**

Accumulation of fluid in the pulmonary interstitium

and alveoli, most commonly due to left-sided heart failure (cardiogenic). Causes increased hydrostatic pressure leads to transudation. Presents with acute dyspnea, orthopnea, crackles, and S3 gallop. Non-cardiogenic causes include ARDS, renal failure, and high altitude.

#### **Synonyms:**

Edema, Pulmonary Edema Pulmonary (Pulmonary Edema)

### **Pulmonary Embolism Treatment**

Anticoagulation: DOACs preferred (rivaroxaban, apixaban) or LMWH bridging to warfarin. Duration: 3 months for provoked (reversible risk factor), indefinite for unprovoked or recurrent. Massive PE: systemic thrombolysis (alteplase 100 mg IV over 2 hours) or surgical catheter-directed embolectomy.

### **Pulmonary Fibrosis**

Scarring replacing normal alveolar architecture. Causes: IPF, connective tissue disease, asbestos, radiation, drugs (bleomycin, methotrexate). Features: progressive dyspnea, dry cough, digital clubbing.

### **Pulmonary Function Tests**

Spirometry: FVC (forced vital capacity), FEV1 (forced expiratory volume in 1 second), FEV1/FVC ratio. Obstructive pattern: FEV1/FVC <0.7 (asthma, COPD). Restrictive pattern: FVC <80% with normal or increased FEV1/FVC (pulmonary fibrosis, chest wall disorders). Lung volumes: TLC (total lung capacity), RV (residual volume).

### **Pulmonary Hemosiderosis**

Accumulation of iron-containing pigment in the lungs, usually after repeated bleeding into the air spaces. It may cause cough, coughing blood, anemia, shortness of breath, or diffuse lung changes and can result from immune-mediated or other disorders.

### **Pulmonary Hypertension**

Elevated mean pulmonary artery pressure (>20 mmHg at rest) due to various etiologies. WHO Group 1: pulmonary arterial hypertension (idiopathic, heritable, drug-induced). Group 2: left heart disease. Group 3: lung disease. Group 4:

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chronic thromboembolic.

**Synonyms:**

PH (Pulmonary Hypertension)

**Pulmonary Hypertension Classification**

WHO Classification: Group 1 (PAH: idiopathic, heritable, drug-induced, connective tissue disease-associated). Group 2 (left heart disease: systolic/diastolic dysfunction, valvular). Group 3 (lung disease/hypoxia: COPD, ILD, sleep apnea). Group 4 (chronic thromboembolic). Group 5 (multifactorial: sarcoidosis, hematologic disorders).

**Pulmonary Infarction**

Lung necrosis from PE when bronchial supply is compromised. Causes pleuritic pain, hemoptysis, and wedge-shaped opacity. Most PE do not cause infarction due to dual blood supply.

**Pulmonary Lobes**

The anatomical divisions of the lungs separated by interlobar fissures. The right lung has superior, middle, and inferior lobes; the left lung has superior and inferior lobes and a lingula.

**Pulmonary Rehabilitation**

A supervised, multidisciplinary program combining exercise training, education, behavioral support, and self-management for chronic respiratory disease. It improves exercise capacity, dyspnea, functional status, and quality of life.

**Pulmonary Sequestration**

A congenital malformation of non-functioning lung tissue that lacks normal communication with the tracheobronchial tree and receives its blood supply from a systemic artery (usually the descending aorta). Intralobar sequestration is within the normal pleural investment; extralobar is outside.

**Pulmonary Surfactant**

A phospholipid-protein mixture produced by type II alveolar pneumocytes that reduces surface tension at the air-liquid interface within alveoli. The primary component is dipalmitoylphosphatidylcholine (DPPC, lecithin), which forms a monolayer that re-

duces surface tension to near zero during expiration.

**Pulmonary Valve**

Semilunar valve between right ventricle and pulmonary trunk with three cusps. Most superiorly located cardiac valve with thinner cusps than the aortic valve. Pulmonic stenosis is a congenital defect causing right ventricular hypertrophy. Less commonly affected by endocarditis than mitral/aortic valves.

**Pulmonary Vascular Resistance**

The resistance to blood flow through the pulmonary circulation, calculated approximately as the transpulmonary pressure gradient divided by cardiac output. Elevated resistance contributes to pulmonary hypertension and right-ventricular afterload.

**Pulmonary Vasodilator Therapy**

Medications that reduce pulmonary vascular resistance and pulmonary artery pressure. Used for WHO Group 1 PAH. Includes endothelin receptor antagonists (bosentan), PDE-5 inhibitors (sildenafil), prostacyclin analogs (epoprostenol), and soluble guanylate cyclase stimulators (riociguat).

**Pulmonary Vein**

The four veins (two from each lung) returning oxygenated blood from the lungs to the left atrium, a unique exception in the venous system (carrying oxygenated blood). Superior and inferior pulmonary veins enter the left atrium posteriorly.

**Pulmonary Wedge Pressure**

The pressure measured by a balloon-tipped pulmonary artery catheter when the balloon is inflated, occluding a branch of the pulmonary artery. It approximates left atrial pressure. Normal is 6–12 mmHg. Elevated in left heart failure (PCWP > 18 mmHg). Low in hypovolemia.

**Pulmonary-Artery Dissection**

Rare but life-threatening tear in the pulmonary artery wall, most commonly associated with pulmonary hypertension, Marfan syndrome, or prior

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pulmonary artery catheterization. Presents with acute chest pain, dyspnea, and hemodynamic collapse. Diagnosis by CT angiography or echocardiography; management requires emergent surgical repair.

### **Pulp Stone**

Calcified mass in pulp chamber or root canal. May be free, attached, or embedded. Incidental finding.

### **Pulpectomy**

Complete removal of pulp from primary tooth. Followed by resorbable filling material.

### **Pulposus**

Relating to the nucleus pulposus, the gelatinous central portion of an intervertebral disk.

### **Pulpotomy**

Removal of coronal pulp in primary tooth with reversible inflammation. Maintains radicular pulp vitality.

### **Pulse Examination**

Assessment of arterial pulses for rate, rhythm, strength, and symmetry to help evaluate circulation.

### **Pulse Oximeter**

A noninvasive device that estimates peripheral oxygen saturation using light absorption. Readings can be affected by poor perfusion, motion, skin or nail characteristics, device limitations, and the clinical setting.

### **Pulse Oximetry**

A noninvasive method for estimating peripheral oxygen saturation by measuring red and infrared light absorption through a pulsatile vascular bed. It is widely used for monitoring, but values must be interpreted with symptoms, perfusion, device limitations, and the individual's clinical targets.

### **Pulseless Electrical Activity**

A cardiac arrest rhythm organized electrical activity without a detectable pulse. PEA has many

reversible causes (5 H's and 5 T's): hypovolemia, hypoxia, hydrogen ion (acidosis), hypo/hyperkalemia, hypothermia; tension pneumothorax, tamponade (cardiac), toxins, thrombosis (pulmonary), thrombosis (coronary).

### **Pulsus Paradoxus**

A decrease in systolic blood pressure greater than 10 mmHg during inspiration, normally less than 10 mmHg. Exaggerated in cardiac tamponade (due to ventricular interdependence in the confined pericardial space), severe asthma, COPD exacerbation, and constrictive pericarditis.

### **Punch Biopsy**

A small, full-thickness circular biopsy obtained with a rotating trephine, used to diagnose skin and soft-tissue lesions. Suture closure may be needed.

### **Punctate Hemorrhages (Tardieu Spots)**

Small, pinpoint sub-ecchymotic hemorrhages (petechiae) resulting from the rupture of small capillaries under conditions of intense mechanical venous engorgement and asphyxia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tardieu Spots

### **Punctate Palmoplantar Keratoderma**

A hereditary keratoderma characterised by multiple, small, firm, circumscribed keratotic papules and plaques scattered across the palms and soles, often with an autosomal dominant inheritance pattern. It may present in adolescence or adulthood and can be associated with malignant transformation in rare cases.

### **Pure Tone Audiometry**

The standard behavioral test used to measure hearing sensitivity across the frequency range important for speech perception, typically from 250 to 8000 Hertz, by determining the lowest intensity level at which a pure tone can be detected approximately fifty percent of the time (the hearing threshold).

### **Purging**

Deliberate behaviors intended to compensate for

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eating, such as self-induced vomiting or misuse of laxatives, diuretics, or excessive exercise.

### **Purging Disorder**

Recurrent purging behavior to influence weight or shape in the absence of binge eating. Self-induced vomiting, misuse of laxatives, diuretics, or other medications. It is classified under Other Specified Feeding or Eating Disorder (OSFED). It can lead to electrolyte imbalances, dental erosion, Russell's sign, and esophageal tears.

### **Purines**

Nitrogenous bases containing a double-ring structure (a six-membered ring fused to a five-membered imidazole ring), which serve as essential components of nucleotides in DNA and RNA. The primary purines are adenine (A) and guanine (G).

### **Purkinje Fibers**

The terminal branches of the cardiac conduction system, distributed throughout the ventricular myocardium. They conduct impulses rapidly (up to 4 m/s) to ensure coordinated ventricular contraction from apex to base. Purkinje fibers have an intrinsic firing rate of 20-40 beats per minute.

### **Purpura Fulminans**

A rapidly progressive, life-threatening condition characterised by extensive, confluent, non-blanching purpuric skin necrosis with haemorrhagic bullae, resulting from acute intravascular thrombosis and disseminated intravascular coagulation.

### **Purulent Pericarditis**

Bacterial infection of the pericardial space, most commonly caused by *S. aureus*, *S. pneumoniae*, or gram-negative organisms. Often occurs as a complication of pneumonia, endocarditis, chest surgery, or immunosuppression. Presents with fever, pleuritic chest pain, and rapidly accumulating effusion with tamponade physiology.

### **Push Enteroscopy**

Endoscopic technique using a longer endoscope to visualize and intervene in the proximal small bowel

beyond the reach of standard upper endoscopy. Unlike capsule endoscopy, push enteroscopy allows direct visualization with the ability to obtain biopsies and perform hemostasis.

### **Pyelotomy**

An incision into the renal pelvis, usually made to remove an obstruction or kidney stone.

### **Pylephlebitis**

Septic thrombophlebitis of the portal vein or its tributaries, most commonly arising from intra-abdominal infections such as appendicitis, diverticulitis, cholangitis, or hepatic abscess. Presents with high fever, rigors, right upper quadrant pain, jaundice, and sepsis.

### **Pyoderma Gangrenosum**

A neutrophilic inflammatory skin disorder that causes painful ulcers with undermined, violaceous borders. It may be associated with inflammatory bowel disease, arthritis, blood disorders, or other systemic conditions, and trauma can worsen the lesions.

### **Pyogenic Granuloma**

A benign vascular proliferation presenting as a rapidly growing, friable, red papule or nodule that bleeds easily. It commonly occurs on fingers, face, and lips, and may be triggered by trauma or pregnancy (epulis gravidarum). Diagnosis is clinical.

### **Pyonephrosis**

Pus in renal collecting system. Urological emergency. Requires drainage (stent or nephrostomy) and antibiotics.

### **Pyostomatitis Vegetans**

A rare, chronic, inflammatory oral mucosal condition characterized by multiple, soft, yellowish, vegetative pustules on an erythematous base, predominantly affecting the buccal mucosa and gingiva. It is strongly associated with inflammatory bowel disease, particularly ulcerative colitis, and may precede gastrointestinal symptoms.



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### **Pyridoxine (Vitamin B6)**

A vitamin converted to pyridoxal phosphate, a coenzyme for transamination, decarboxylation, and other amino-acid reactions. Deficiency can cause neuropathy, dermatitis, seizures, and sideroblastic anemia; excessive supplementation can also cause neuropathy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vitamin B6

### **Pyrimidines**

Nitrogenous bases containing a single six-membered heterocyclic ring, serving as structural building blocks for nucleic acids. The primary pyrimidines are cytosine (C), thymine (T, present in DNA), and uracil (U, present in RNA).

### **Pyruvate**

The three-carbon alpha-keto acid produced at the end of glycolysis from phosphoenolpyruvate by pyruvate kinase.

### **Pyruvate Dehydrogenase**

Converts pyruvate to acetyl-CoA. Regulated by phosphorylation (inactivated by PDH kinase). Requires thiamine, lipoate, CoA, FAD, NAD+.

### **Pyruvate Kinase Deficiency**

An inherited red-cell glycolytic defect causing chronic hemolytic anemia of variable severity. Manifestations include jaundice, splenomegaly, gallstones, fatigue, and complications of iron overload.

### **Pannus**

An abnormal layer of vascularized tissue that grows over a joint or the cornea.

### **Parasomnias**

Unwanted movements, behaviors, emotions, or experiences that occur during sleep or at the transition between sleep and wakefulness.

### **Parathyroid Hormone**

A hormone that regulates calcium and phosphate levels in the blood and supports bone remodeling.

### **Paroxysmal Hemicrania**

A rare headache disorder causing brief, repeated attacks of severe one-sided head or facial pain.

### **Patch Test**

A skin test used to identify delayed allergic contact reactions to substances applied under adhesive patches.

### **Pattern-Recognition Receptors**

Immune receptors that detect common molecular features of pathogens or damaged cells.

### **PDE5 Inhibitors**

Medicines that increase penile blood flow by inhibiting phosphodiesterase type 5; they are used mainly to treat erectile dysfunction.

### **Percutaneous Discectomy**

Removal of part of a herniated spinal disk through a small skin incision.

### **Perfusion Defect**

An area receiving abnormally low blood flow, identified by an imaging or functional test.

### **Peyronie's Disease**

A condition in which scar tissue in the penis causes curvature or pain during erection.

### **Phagocytes**

Immune cells that engulf and digest microorganisms, dead cells, and other particles.

### **Phonophobia**

Abnormal sensitivity to or fear of sound, often associated with migraine.

### **Photorefractive Keratectomy**

Laser eye surgery that reshapes the cornea to correct refractive errors.

### **Physical Dependence**

A state in which the body adapts to a substance



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or medication and develops withdrawal symptoms when it is reduced or stopped.

### **Posterior Myocardial Infarction**

A heart attack involving the back wall of the heart.

### **Postherpetic Neuralgia**

Persistent nerve pain in an area affected by shingles after the rash has healed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neuralgia, Postherpetic

### **Primary Hypertension**

High blood pressure without an identifiable single underlying cause.

### **Procedural Memory**

Long-term memory for learned skills and procedures.

### **Prolapsed Disk**

A spinal disk that bulges or ruptures and may compress a nearby nerve; also called a herniated disk.

#### **Synonyms:**

a herniated disk.

### **Proliferative Retinopathy**

Advanced retinal disease in which abnormal new blood vessels grow and may bleed or impair vision.

### **Prostatic Urethral Stent**

A small device placed in the prostatic urethra to help maintain urine flow when the prostate obstructs it.

### **Proctocolitis**

Inflammation of the rectum and the adjacent portion of the colon.

### **Pulmonary Emphysema**

A chronic lung disease in which damage to the air sacs reduces the lungs' ability to exchange gases.

### **Park-Bench Position**

A modified lateral position in which the upper body is partly rotated toward prone; it is used for selected posterior brain and neck procedures.

### **Prone Position**

A position in which the patient lies face down, commonly providing access to the back, spine, buttocks, or posterior legs.

### **Pancolitis**

Inflammation affecting the entire colon, often as an extensive form of ulcerative colitis.

### **Pancreatic Cysts**

Fluid-filled sacs in or around the pancreas, which may be benign or precancerous.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst, Pancreatic Cysts Pancreatic Inflammatory (Pancreatic Cysts) Cysts True Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts) Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts) IPMN Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts) Mucinous Cyst Adenomas Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Inflammatory Cysts (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas IPMN (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Mucinous Cyst Adenomas (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Non-Inflammatory Cysts (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Pseudocysts (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Serous Cyst Adenomas (Pancreatic Cysts) Pancreas Solid Pseudopapillary Tumor (Pancreatic Cysts) Serous Cyst Adenomas Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)

### **Panic Attacks And Panic Disorder**

Panic attacks are sudden episodes of intense fear; panic disorder involves recurrent attacks and persistent concern about having more.

### **Parotid Tumors**

Abnormal growths arising in the parotid salivary glands, located in front of and below the ears.

### **Parvovirus Infection**

An infection caused by parvovirus B19 that com-

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monly causes mild fever and rash but may be serious in some people.

**Synonyms:**

Slapped Cheek Disease

**Peanut Allergy**

An immune reaction to peanut proteins that can cause symptoms ranging from hives to life-threatening anaphylaxis.

**Pediatric Brain Tumors**

Tumors that develop in the brain or nearby tissues of children.

**Synonyms:**

Brain Tumor, Child

**Pediatric Obstructive Sleep Apnea**

Repeated blockage of a child's upper airway during sleep, causing pauses in breathing.

**Synonyms:**

Obstructive Sleep Apnea In Children Sleep Apnea In Children, Obstructive

**Penicillin Allergy**

An immune reaction to penicillin antibiotics that may cause rash, swelling, breathing difficulty, or anaphylaxis.

**Peripheral Nerve Tumors**

Tumors that arise from or around nerves outside the brain and spinal cord.

**Postconcussion Syndrome**

Persistent physical, cognitive, or emotional symptoms after a concussion.

**Precordium**

The region of the chest overlying the heart.

**Philadelphia Chromosome**

A chromosome rearrangement, usually t(9;22), that creates the BCR::ABL1 fusion gene and is characteristic of most cases of chronic myeloid leukemia.

**Phonocardiography**

Graphic recording of heart sounds and murmurs using a microphone and recording system.

**Phorometer**

An instrument used to measure ocular alignment and the amount of prism correction needed for binocular vision disorders.

**Photosensitization**

Increased sensitivity to ultraviolet or visible light caused by a medication, chemical, or disease, producing an exaggerated skin reaction.

**Physical Examination**

A systematic assessment of the body using inspection, palpation, percussion, auscultation, and other examination methods.

**Physical Therapy**

Rehabilitation using exercise, movement training, manual techniques, and physical modalities to improve function, mobility, and reduce disability.

**Phytomedicine**

The evidence-based use of medicinal products derived from plants to prevent or treat disease.

**Pitting Edema**

Swelling in which pressure applied to the skin leaves a temporary indentation, usually because of excess interstitial fluid.

**Placental Abnormalities**

Disorders of placental location, attachment, structure, or separation that may affect pregnancy or cause bleeding.

**Placenta Previa**

Implantation of the placenta over or near the internal cervical opening, which can cause painless bleeding during the second half of pregnancy.

**Plasmin**

A proteolytic enzyme that breaks down fibrin and

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helps dissolve blood clots.

### **Plethysmography**

Plethysmography examines plethysmography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Disorders**

Conditions affecting the pleura, including pleural effusion, pneumothorax, pleurisy, infection, and tumors.

### **Pleural Space**

The potential space between the visceral and parietal pleura surrounding each lung.

### **Pneumoplasty**

Surgical repair or reconstruction of lung tissue or an airway.

### **Pneumotachometer**

An instrument that measures the rate of airflow during breathing.

### **Protein Electrophoresis**

A laboratory test that separates proteins in serum or urine according to their electrical properties, helping detect abnormal protein patterns.

### **Pseudophakia**

The presence of an artificial intraocular lens after removal of the natural lens, usually during cataract surgery.

### **Pulmonary Circuit**

The circulation in which blood travels from the right ventricle to the lungs for gas exchange and returns to the left atrium.

### **Pulmonary Ventilation**

The movement of air into and out of the lungs.

### **Palatine Tonsils**

Paired masses of lymphoid tissue on the sides of the oropharynx that contribute to immune defense.

### **Pancreatic Islets**

Clusters of endocrine cells in the pancreas that release hormones such as insulin, glucagon, somatostatin, and pancreatic polypeptide.

### **Panhypopituitarism**

Deficiency of most or all anterior pituitary hormones due to disease of the pituitary gland or hypothalamus.

### **Pelvimetry**

Measurement of the dimensions of the maternal pelvis, usually to assess selected obstetric concerns.

### **Peripartum**

The period immediately before, during, and shortly after childbirth.

### **Peyer Patches**

Aggregated lymphoid follicles in the mucosa and submucosa of the ileum that monitor intestinal contents and support immune defense.

### **Primigravida**

A person who is pregnant for the first time.

### **Pes Anserinus**

The combined tendon insertion of the sartorius, gracilis, and semitendinosus muscles on the antero-medial proximal tibia; inflammation there is pes-anserine bursitis.

### **Pilonidal Cyst**

A cyst or sinus in the cleft between the buttocks, usually containing hair and skin debris. It may become infected, painful, swollen, and drain pus.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst, Pilonidal Pilonidal Sinus (Pilonidal Cyst)

### **Polyneuropathy**

A generalized disorder affecting multiple peripheral nerves, often causing symmetric numbness, tingling, burning pain, weakness, or impaired reflexes in the limbs.

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## Puncture Wound

A wound produced when a pointed object penetrates the skin and underlying tissue, creating a small surface opening with potentially deep tissue damage and infection risk.

## Parathyroid Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor of the parathyroid gland that commonly causes excessive parathyroid-hormone secretion, hypercalcemia, kidney stones, bone disease, or related symptoms.

## Pasteurellosis

Infection caused by *Pasteurella* bacteria, commonly introduced through animal bites or scratches and causing cellulitis, abscesses, or occasionally invasive disease.

## Pathophysiology

The study of the functional changes produced by disease or injury and the mechanisms through which they cause signs and symptoms.

## Pavor Nocturnus (Night Terrors)

Episodes of sudden intense fear, screaming, and autonomic arousal during sleep, usually arising from deep non-REM sleep and often followed by little or no memory.

### Synonyms:

Night Terrors

## Pectoriloquy

Abnormally clear transmission of spoken sounds through the chest wall, often suggesting lung consolidation or another change in lung tissue.

## Penumbra

Brain tissue surrounding an area of infarction that is functionally impaired but potentially salvageable if blood flow is restored promptly.

## Post-Natal Depression

Depression beginning during pregnancy or after childbirth, with persistent low mood or loss of interest and possible effects on sleep, bonding, and daily

functioning.

## Post-Partum Haemorrhage

Excessive bleeding after childbirth, most commonly caused by failure of the uterus to contract, retained placental tissue, genital-tract trauma, or clotting problems.

## Premature Birth

Birth before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy; the earlier the birth, the greater the risks of respiratory, neurological, and developmental complications.

## Presbycusis (Presbycusis)

Age-related, usually gradual sensorineural hearing loss, particularly affecting the ability to hear high-frequency sounds and understand speech in noise.

### Synonyms:

Presbycusis

## Prothrombin Time (PT)

A blood test measuring the time required for clot formation through the extrinsic and common coagulation pathways; it is commonly reported as the INR.

### Synonyms:

PT

## Pregnancy Of Unknown Location

A positive pregnancy test without a confirmed intrauterine or ectopic pregnancy on ultrasound. Serial human chorionic gonadotropin measurements and repeat imaging help determine whether the pregnancy is early, failing, or ectopic.

## Postpartum Preeclampsia

New-onset hypertension with pre-eclampsia features after childbirth, sometimes occurring several days or weeks postpartum. Severe headache, visual symptoms, chest pain, shortness of breath, or seizures require urgent assessment.

## Pelvic Girdle Pain In Pregnancy

Pain arising from the pelvic joints and surrounding tissues during pregnancy, often affecting the pubic

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symphysis, sacroiliac joints, hips, or lower back. It may impair walking, turning in bed, or climbing stairs.

### **Postpartum Care**

Clinical care during the weeks after childbirth that assesses bleeding, uterine involution, blood pressure, infection, wound healing, breastfeeding, mental health, contraception, and recovery.

### **Postpartum Urinary Retention**

Inability to empty the bladder adequately after childbirth, sometimes associated with epidural anesthesia, perineal trauma, swelling, or prolonged labor. Prompt assessment prevents bladder overdistension and injury.

### **Postpartum Contraception**

Contraceptive counseling and care after childbirth, taking account of breastfeeding, venous-thromboembolism risk, medical conditions, fertility intentions, and the timing of method initiation.

### **Perinatal Asphyxia**

Impaired oxygenation or ventilation before, during, or shortly after birth that may cause neonatal encephalopathy, organ injury, or death. Immediate newborn assessment and resuscitation are essential.

### **Prenatal Genetic Counseling**

A consultation that reviews the risk of inherited or chromosomal conditions, available screening and diagnostic tests, possible results, and reproductive options before or during pregnancy.

### **Pachyonychia Congenita**

An inherited keratin disorder, usually caused by KRT6A, KRT16, or KRT17 variants, producing thick dystrophic nails, painful palmoplantar keratoderma, and sometimes cysts or oral leukokeratosis.

### **Pacifier**

A pacifier is a nipple-shaped device used to soothe an infant by sucking; safe use includes avoiding cords and sweet coatings and stopping according to

dental and developmental guidance.

### **Pacinian Corpuscle**

A biomedical term referring to pacinian corpuscle; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Packaging Tube**

A packaging tube is a squeezable container for medicines, creams, gels, pastes, or other products, designed to protect contents and allow controlled dispensing.

### **Paclitaxel**

Paclitaxel is a taxane chemotherapy drug that stabilizes microtubules and prevents cell division; it treats several cancers and can cause myelosuppression, neuropathy, alopecia, myalgia, and hypersensitivity reactions.

### **Paclitaxel Liposome**

A medical term referring to paclitaxel liposome. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Paclitaxel Poliglumex**

A medical term referring to paclitaxel poliglumex. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Paecilomyces**

paecilomyces is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Paenibacillus**

paenibacillus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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### **Paenibacillus Alvei**

paenibacillus alvei is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Paenibacillus Phoenicis**

paenibacillus phoenicis is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Paenibacillus Polymyxa**

paenibacillus polymyxa is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Pagetoid Reticulosis**

A rare localized variant of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma with solitary slowly enlarging scaly plaques containing atypical pagetoid lymphocytes.

### **Pain Perception**

A clinical condition or finding involving pain perception. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pain Threshold**

A clinical condition or finding involving pain threshold. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Palatal Muscle**

Muscle of the soft palate that elevates or tenses the palate and helps separate the nasal and oral cavities during swallowing and speech.

### **Palate Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving palate neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Palatine Tonsil**

A biomedical term referring to palatine tonsil; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Palatorrhaphy**

Palatorrhaphy is surgical repair of a cleft or defect of the palate to restore separation between the oral and nasal cavities and improve feeding and speech.

### **Palifermin**

A pharmacologic agent associated with palifermin; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Palivizumab**

A medical term referring to palivizumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Palladium**

A medical term referring to palladium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Palm Oil**

Palm oil is an edible plant oil high in palmitic and oleic acids; its nutritional effects depend on total dietary pattern and the fats it replaces.

### **Palmar Reflex**

The palmar reflex is an infant response in which stroking the palm causes finger flexion; persistence or asymmetry beyond the expected age may indicate neurologic dysfunction.

### **Palmitic Acid**

A 16-carbon saturated fatty acid common in dietary and stored fats; excess saturated-fat intake can contribute to adverse lipid profiles, although the body also synthesizes it normally.

### **Palmoplantar Hyperkeratosis**

Excessive thickening of the skin on the palms and soles, inherited or acquired, causing calluses, fissures,



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pain, impaired walking, and sometimes infection.

### **Palonosetron**

A pharmacologic agent associated with palonosetron; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Palonosetron Hydrochloride**

A long-acting 5-HT<sub>3</sub> serotonin-receptor antagonist used to prevent nausea and vomiting caused by chemotherapy, surgery, or selected other treatments.

### **Palpable**

Palpable means detectable by touch during physical examination, such as a mass, enlarged organ, lymph node, pulse, tenderness, or abnormal surface.

### **Pamidronic Acid**

An intravenous bisphosphonate that inhibits osteoclast-mediated bone resorption and is used for selected hypercalcemia, bone complications of cancer, and Paget disease.

### **Pan Troglodyte**

Pan troglodytes is the scientific name for the common chimpanzee, a great ape and close evolutionary relative of humans used in behavioral and biomedical research.

### **Panax**

Panax is a plant genus that includes ginseng species whose roots are used in traditional products; composition, evidence, interactions, and adverse effects vary by preparation.

### **Pancreas Enzyme**

An enzyme produced by the pancreas, such as amylase, lipase, or proteases, that helps digest carbohydrate, fat, or protein in the small intestine.

### **Pancreas Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pancreas infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host

response.

### **Pancreas Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving pancreas neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pancreas Transplantation**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pancreas transplantation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pancreatic Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving pancreatic carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pancreatic Diseases**

A clinical condition or finding involving pancreatic diseases. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pancreatic Fistula**

A pancreatic fistula is an abnormal passage through which pancreatic juice leaks from the pancreas, often after trauma or surgery, causing fluid collections, ascites, or skin drainage.

### **Pancreatic Hormones**

Hormones produced by pancreatic islet cells, including insulin, glucagon, somatostatin, and pancreatic polypeptide, which regulate glucose, digestion, and energy metabolism.

### **Pancreatic Islet**

A pancreatic islet is a cluster of endocrine cells that releases hormones such as insulin, glucagon, and somatostatin to regulate blood glucose and digestion.

### **Pancreatic Juice**

Pancreatic juice is an alkaline digestive secretion containing bicarbonate and enzymes such as amylase, lipase, and proteases, delivered into the duode-

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num.

### **Pancreaticoduodenectomy**

pancreaticoduodenectomy is used in relation to pancreaticoduodenectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Pancrelipase**

Pancrelipase is a mixture of pancreatic digestive enzymes used as replacement therapy for exocrine pancreatic insufficiency, including that caused by cystic fibrosis or pancreatic disease.

### **Pancuronium**

Pancuronium is a long-acting nondepolarizing neuromuscular blocker that prevents skeletal-muscle contraction during anesthesia or ventilation; it must be given with airway support.

### **Pandoraea**

A biomedical term referring to pandoraea; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pargyline**

Pargyline is an irreversible monoamine-oxidase inhibitor formerly used for hypertension; it is now mainly of historical or research interest because of interactions and adverse effects.

### **Paricalcitol**

Paricalcitol is a vitamin-D receptor activator used to reduce secondary hyperparathyroidism in selected chronic kidney disease, with monitoring for calcium and phosphate changes.

### **Parietal Pleura**

A biomedical term referring to parietal pleura; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Parinaric Acid**

A conjugated polyunsaturated fatty acid used as a fluorescent probe of lipid membranes and studied

in oxidation and lipid-chemistry research.

### **Parity**

Parity is the number of pregnancies that reached a viable gestational age, regardless of whether the infants were born alive or stillborn; it differs from gravidity.

### **Paromomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called paromomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Parosteal Osteosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving parosteal osteosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Parotid Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving parotid neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Parotidectomy**

parotidectomy is used in relation to parotidectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Paroxetine**

Paroxetine is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor used for depression, anxiety disorders, obsessive-compulsive disorder, PTSD, and some other conditions; sexual dysfunction, withdrawal symptoms, serotonin syndrome, and pregnancy-related risks require consideration.

### **Paroxetine Hydrochloride**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called paroxetine hydrochloride. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Pars Compacta**

The substantia nigra pars compacta is a midbrain re-

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gion containing dopamine-producing neurons whose loss contributes to the motor features of Parkinson disease.

### **Pars Planitis**

A form of intermediate uveitis involving inflammatory exudates near the pars plana, causing floaters, blurred vision, and sometimes macular edema or retinal complications.

### **Parthenogenesis**

Development of an embryo from an unfertilized egg; it occurs naturally in some animals and plants and is not a normal mechanism of human reproduction.

### **Partial**

Partial means incomplete or involving only a portion, such as partial loss, partial response, partial thickness, or partial seizure; the specific meaning depends on context.

### **Partial Cystectomy**

partial cystectomy is used in relation to partial cystectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Partial Hysterectomy**

partial hysterectomy is used in relation to partial hysterectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Partial Nephrectomy**

partial nephrectomy is used in relation to partial nephrectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Partial Remission**

A reduction in signs, symptoms, or measurable disease burden that does not meet criteria for complete remission; the definition depends on the disease and response criteria used.

### **Participation**

A person's involvement in life situations and activities, a central concept in rehabilitation and the

International Classification of Functioning that extends beyond impairment alone.

### **Particle Size**

Particle size is the diameter or size distribution of particles in a powder, suspension, aerosol, or formulation, influencing dissolution, absorption, stability, and delivery.

### **Parvimonas Micra**

A biomedical term referring to parvimonas micra; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Parvoviridae**

parvoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Parvovirus**

parvovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Passive Immunization**

Protection produced by giving preformed antibodies, such as immunoglobulin or antivenom, which acts quickly but is temporary because the recipient does not generate durable immune memory.

### **Paste**

A paste is a semisolid preparation or material containing finely divided solids in a liquid or base, used in medicines, dentistry, skin care, and laboratory work.

### **Pasteurella Aerogenes**

pasteurella aerogenes is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

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### **Pasteurella Bettyae**

*pasteurella bettyae* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Pasteurella Canis**

*pasteurella canis* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Pasteurella Pneumotropica**

*pasteurella pneumotropica* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Pasteurellaceae**

*pasteurellaceae* is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Patellar Dislocation**

Complete displacement of the kneecap from the femoral groove, usually laterally, causing acute pain, deformity, swelling, and difficulty extending the knee.

### **Patent Urachus**

A patent urachus is persistence of the fetal channel between the bladder and umbilicus after birth, allowing urine to drain from the umbilicus and predisposing to infection.

### **Paternal Behavior**

Paternal behavior includes caregiving, protection, bonding, and other behaviors by a father or male caregiver; it is shaped by biology, experience, culture, and circumstances.

### **Pathologic Dilatation**

Abnormal widening of a hollow organ, duct, blood vessel, or other structure beyond its expected size

because of obstruction, weakness, pressure, or disease.

### **Pathologic Ossification**

Abnormal formation of bone in soft tissue or in a location where bone should not develop, as in heterotopic ossification after trauma, neurologic injury, or surgery.

### **Pathologic Process**

A pathologic process is an abnormal biological change that produces disease, such as infection, inflammation, ischemia, degeneration, abnormal growth, or immune injury.

### **Pathologic Response**

A pathologic response is an abnormal reaction of cells, tissues, or organs to injury, infection, immune activation, toxins, or other stressors that contributes to disease.

### **Pathological Fracture**

A clinical condition or finding involving pathological fracture. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pathologist**

A pathologist is a physician who diagnoses disease by examining tissues, cells, blood, or body fluids and may guide laboratory testing, cancer classification, and treatment decisions.

### **Patient Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to patient care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Patient Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to patient discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

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## Patient Observation

Systematic monitoring of a patient's symptoms, vital signs, examination findings, behavior, and response to treatment to detect deterioration or guide management.

## Patient Rights

Ethical and legal protections for people receiving care, including informed consent, privacy, access to information, respectful treatment, participation in decisions, and refusal of treatment where lawful.

## Paxillin

Paxillin is a focal-adhesion adaptor protein that links integrin signaling to the actin cytoskeleton and helps regulate cell adhesion, migration, and mechanical sensing.

## Pazopanib

A medical term referring to pazopanib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peanut Oil

Peanut oil is oil extracted from peanuts; refined oil usually contains little allergenic protein, whereas unrefined products may trigger reactions in susceptible people.

## Peau D'Orange

Peau d'orange is dimpled skin resembling an orange peel, caused by edema tethered around hair follicles; it can occur with breast cancer, infection, or lymphatic obstruction.

## Pectin

Pectin is a soluble plant fiber that forms gels and may alter stool consistency and absorption; it is used in foods, formulations, and some nutritional products.

## Pectinate Line

The pectinate line is the junction in the anal canal between regions with different embryologic origin, blood supply, lymphatic drainage, sensation, and venous anatomy.

## Pectoral Girdle

The pectoral girdle consists of the clavicles and scapulae, attaching the upper limbs to the trunk and providing broad surfaces for shoulder and arm movement.

## Pectoralis Muscles

The pectoralis major and minor muscles of the chest, which move and stabilize the shoulder and assist with movements such as pushing, adduction, and breathing.

## Pediatric AIDS

Pediatric AIDS is advanced HIV infection in a child, with severe immune suppression or AIDS-defining illness; antiretroviral therapy and prevention of opportunistic infection are essential.

## Pediatric Nursing

Pediatric nursing provides age-appropriate care to infants, children, and adolescents, accounting for growth, development, family involvement, communication, safety, and medication differences.

## Pediatric Obesity

Excess body fat in a child or adolescent defined using age- and sex-specific BMI percentiles, associated with metabolic, orthopedic, respiratory, psychosocial, and cardiovascular risks.

## Pediococcus

pediococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

## Pediococcus Pentosaceus

pediococcus pentosaceus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

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### **Pedophilia**

Pedophilia is a psychiatric term for a persistent sexual interest in prepubescent children; sexual contact with a child is abuse and illegal, and safety-focused professional help is required.

### **Pedunculate**

Pedunculate describes a structure, lesion, or polyp attached by a narrow stalk rather than a broad base.

### **Peer Review**

Peer review is evaluation of research, clinical work, or scholarly writing by qualified independent reviewers to assess methods, evidence, clarity, and significance.

### **Pefloxacin**

A pharmacologic agent associated with pefloxacin; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Pegargiminase**

A pharmacologic agent associated with pegargiminase; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Pegaspargase**

A pharmacologic agent associated with pegaspargase; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Pegdinetanib**

A medical term referring to pegdinetanib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pegfilgrastim**

A pharmacologic agent associated with pegfilgrastim; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Peldesine**

Peldesine is an investigational sphingosine-1-phosphate lyase inhibitor studied for effects on immune-cell trafficking and inflammatory or autoimmune disease.

### **Pelitrexol**

Pelitrexol is an investigational antifolate drug that inhibits thymidylate synthase and has been studied as an antineoplastic agent.

### **Pellet**

A pellet is a small compacted mass of medication, material, or tissue; drug pellets may be formulated for implantation or controlled release.

### **Pelvic Bone**

The ring of bones formed by the paired hip bones, sacrum, and coccyx that supports the trunk, protects pelvic organs, and transmits weight to the lower limbs.

### **Pelvic Diaphragm**

A biomedical term referring to pelvic diaphragm; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pelvic Examination**

Clinical inspection and palpation of the external genitalia, vagina, cervix, uterus, and adnexa to evaluate bleeding, pain, discharge, lesions, pregnancy-related findings, or infection.

### **Pelvic Exenteration**

Extensive surgery removing selected pelvic organs and surrounding tissues, reserved for carefully selected locally advanced or recurrent cancers when less radical treatment is inadequate.

### **Pelvic Girdle**

A biomedical term referring to pelvic girdle; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.



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### **Pelvic Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pelvic infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pelvic Kidney**

A kidney that remains in the pelvis rather than ascending to its usual lumbar position during development; it may be asymptomatic or associated with abnormal drainage, stones, infection, or vascular anatomy.

### **Pelvic Lymphadenectomy**

pelvic lymphadenectomy is used in relation to pelvic lymphadenectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Pelvic Mass**

A biomedical term referring to pelvic mass; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pelvic Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving pelvic neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pelvic Viscus**

A biomedical term referring to pelvic viscus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pemetrexed**

Pemetrexed is a folate-antimetabolite chemotherapy drug that inhibits several enzymes involved in nucleotide synthesis, used especially for mesothelioma and nonsquamous non-small-cell lung cancer; folic acid and vitamin B12 reduce toxicity.

### **Pemetrexed Disodium**

A medical term referring to pemetrexed disodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pemoline**

Pemoline is a stimulant formerly used for attention-deficit disorders; serious liver toxicity led to withdrawal or severe restriction in many countries.

### **Penbutolol**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called penbutolol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Penclomedine**

Penclomedine is an investigational antineoplastic compound studied for cytotoxic effects against cancer cells and is not a routine clinical medicine.

### **Pendulous**

Pendulous means hanging loosely from a supporting structure, as in a pedunculated lesion, drooping tissue, or an organ suspended by a stalk.

### **Penicillin G**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called penicillin g. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Penicillin V**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called penicillin v. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Penicillium**

A medical term referring to penicillium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Penile Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving penile disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Penile Erection**

Rigidity of the penis caused by increased arterial inflow and reduced venous outflow after sexual or

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reflex stimulation; persistent difficulty obtaining or maintaining it is erectile dysfunction.

### **Penile Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving penile infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Penile Leukoplakia**

A clinical condition involving penile Leukoplakia; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Penis Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving penis carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Penoscrotal Transposition**

A congenital difference in which the penis and scrotum are positioned abnormally relative to each other, often associated with hypospadias or other genital and urinary anomalies.

### **Pentadecanoic Acid**

A 15-carbon saturated fatty acid found in small amounts in dairy and ruminant fats and used in nutritional and lipid-metabolism research.

### **Pentamidine Isethionate**

An antiprotozoal and antimicrobial drug used in selected cases of *Pneumocystis pneumonia*, leishmaniasis, trypanosomiasis, and other infections; toxicity includes hypoglycemia, kidney injury, and arrhythmia.

### **Pentatrichomonas Hominis**

*Pentatrichomonas hominis* is a flagellated intestinal protozoan generally regarded as nonpathogenic; finding it in stool usually indicates exposure to fecal contamination.

### **Pentetic Acid**

A chelating compound that binds metal ions and

is used in selected radiopharmaceuticals, contrast agents, or laboratory applications.

### **Pentosan Polysulfate**

A medical term referring to pentosan polysulfate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pentose**

A pentose is a five-carbon sugar, including ribose in RNA and deoxyribose in DNA, and participates in nucleotide and carbohydrate metabolism.

### **Pentoxifylline**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pentoxifylline; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pentylene-tetrazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called pentylene-tetrazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Peplomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called peplomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Pepsin A**

Pepsin A is a stomach protease activated by acid that begins digestion of dietary proteins into smaller peptides.

### **Peptic Esophagitis**

Inflammation and injury of the esophageal lining caused mainly by repeated gastroesophageal reflux of acid or bile, producing heartburn, chest discomfort, swallowing pain, or strictures.

### **Peptichemio**

A medical term referring to peptichemio. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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## Peptide Biosynthesis

peptide biosynthesis concerns peptide biosynthesis, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Peptide Hormone

A hormone made of amino acids that binds a cell-surface receptor and regulates processes such as metabolism, growth, reproduction, stress, and fluid balance.

## Peptide Library

peptide library concerns peptide library, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Peptide Metabolism

peptide metabolism concerns peptide metabolism, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Peptide Transport

peptide transport concerns peptide transport, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Peptide Yy

peptide yy concerns peptide yy, a biologic or physiologic concept used in research, laboratory medicine, and the explanation of disease.

## Peptidoglycan

A medical term referring to peptidoglycan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peptococcaceae

A medical term referring to peptococcaceae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peptococcus

peptococcus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or

colonization.

## Peptococcus Niger

peptococcus niger is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Peptoniphilus

A medical term referring to peptoniphilus. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peptoniphilus Harei

A medical term referring to peptoniphilus harei. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peptoniphilus Indolicus

A medical term referring to peptoniphilus indolicus. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Peptostreptococcus

peptostreptococcus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Peracetic Acid

A strong oxidizing disinfectant and sterilant used for equipment and surfaces; concentrated exposure irritates or burns skin, eyes, and airways.

## Peracute

Peracute describes disease or a clinical event that develops extremely rapidly, often over minutes to hours, with little time for adaptation or diagnosis.

## Perception

The brain's process of organizing and interpreting sensory information into an experience of objects, events, body sensations, or the environment.

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### **Perceptual Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving perceptual disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Perceptual Distortion**

An inaccurate or altered interpretation of a real sensory stimulus, which may occur with neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, drugs, migraine, seizures, or sensory impairment.

### **Perceptual Masking**

Reduction in the ability to detect or identify one sensory stimulus because another stimulus overlaps it in time, space, or processing.

### **Percutaneous Discectomy**

percutaneous discectomy is used in relation to percutaneous discectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Perforant Pathway**

A biomedical term referring to perforant pathway; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Performance**

Performance describes how effectively a person, organ, treatment, test, or system carries out a defined task; the relevant measure depends on the clinical context.

### **Performed Diagnosis**

A diagnosis established after clinical assessment and appropriate testing identifies the condition explaining a patient's findings; it should be distinguished from a symptom or provisional impression.

### **Performed Histopathology**

A medical term referring to performed histopathology. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Performed Procedure**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to performed procedure; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Perfusion Culture**

A laboratory culture system in which cells or tissue receive continuously renewed nutrient medium, supporting controlled study of growth, metabolism, infection, or drug effects.

### **Pergolide**

A pharmacologic agent associated with pergolide; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Perianal**

Located around the anus; the term describes the skin, glands, pain, inflammation, abscesses, fistulas, and other findings in that region.

### **Perianal Abscess**

A localized collection of pus near the anus caused by infected anal glands or surrounding tissue, producing severe throbbing pain, swelling, fever, and sometimes a fistula.

### **Perianal Glands**

Small glands near the anus that contribute secretions to the local tissue; obstruction or infection can contribute to perianal abscesses and fistulas.

### **Periarteritis Nodosa**

An older name for polyarteritis nodosa, a necrotizing vasculitis of medium-sized arteries that can cause skin, nerve, muscle, kidney, and abdominal ischemic symptoms without typical glomerulonephritis.

### **Periarticular**

Periarticular means located around a joint, including nearby tendons, bursae, ligaments, capsule, and soft tissues rather than the joint surface itself.

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### **Pericardial Mesothelioma**

A biomedical term referring to pericardial mesothelioma; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pericardial Stripping**

A biomedical term referring to pericardial stripping; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pericardial Wall**

A biomedical term referring to pericardial wall; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pericardiectomy**

pericardiectomy is used in relation to pericardiectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Pericardiostomy**

A biomedical term referring to pericardiostomy; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pericytes**

Pericytes are contractile support cells wrapped around small blood vessels that help regulate capillary stability, blood flow, repair, and the blood-brain barrier.

### **Perifosine**

Perifosine is an investigational alkylphospholipid that affects cell-membrane signaling, including AKT pathways, and has been studied in cancer treatment.

### **Perillyl Alcohol**

Perillyl alcohol is a monoterpene found in some plant oils and studied experimentally for effects on cell signaling and cancer growth.

### **Perilymph**

A biomedical term referring to perilymph; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Perimenopausal**

Perimenopausal describes the years of hormonal and menstrual transition before and around menopause, when cycles, bleeding, hot flashes, sleep, and fertility may change.

### **Perinatal Death**

A clinical condition involving perinatal Death; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Perindopril**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called perindopril. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Perineural**

Perineural means around a nerve; the term may describe normal connective tissue, inflammation, tumor spread, or imaging findings surrounding a nerve.

### **Perineuronal Satellitosis**

Clustering of glial cells around a neuron, seen microscopically in some brain tumors, inflammatory conditions, and reactive processes; its significance depends on the surrounding pathology.

### **Perinuclear Space**

The narrow compartment between the inner and outer nuclear membranes, continuous with the endoplasmic-reticulum lumen and involved in nuclear-envelope structure.

### **Periodic Acid**

An oxidizing acid used in histochemistry, especially the periodic-acid-Schiff reaction, which highlights carbohydrates, mucosubstances, fungi, and basement membranes.

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### **Periodontal Cyst**

A periodontal cyst is a fluid-filled epithelial-lined lesion near the tooth-supporting tissues, with effects ranging from incidental discovery to local bone destruction.

### **Periodontal Dressing**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving periodontal dressing. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Periodontist**

A periodontist is a dentist specializing in prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of gum disease and supporting tissues, including periodontal surgery and implants.

### **Periodontium Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving periodontium disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Periorbital Edema**

A clinical condition or finding involving periorbital edema. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Periorbital Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving periorbital infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Peripheral Blood**

Peripheral blood is blood obtained from a vein or capillary rather than directly from an organ or marrow, used for counts, smears, chemistry, and other testing.

### **Peripheral Ischemia**

Inadequate arterial blood flow to an arm, leg, digit, or other peripheral tissue, causing pain, pallor, coolness, weak pulses, numbness, ulcers, or tissue loss.

### **Peripheral Nerve**

A nerve outside the brain and spinal cord that carries motor, sensory, and autonomic signals between the central nervous system and the rest of the body.

### **Periplasm**

The periplasm is the space between the inner and outer membranes of Gram-negative bacteria, containing enzymes, transport proteins, and structural components.

### **Perirenal Hematoma**

A clinical condition involving perirenal Hematoma; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Peritoneal**

Peritoneal means relating to the peritoneum, the thin membrane lining the abdominal cavity and covering many abdominal organs.

### **Peritoneal Cavity**

The potential space between the parietal and visceral peritoneum surrounding abdominal and pelvic organs; fluid, blood, pus, or tumor cells can accumulate there.

### **Peritoneal Diseases**

A clinical condition or finding involving peritoneal diseases. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Peritoneal Fluid**

Peritoneal fluid is the small amount of lubricating fluid in the abdominal cavity; excess or infected fluid may cause ascites, peritonitis, or diagnostic findings.

### **Peritoneal Lavage**

Peritoneal lavage is washing or sampling the abdominal cavity with sterile fluid, historically used to detect internal bleeding or contamination and sometimes used therapeutically.



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### **Peritoneal Necrosis**

Death of peritoneal tissue caused by ischemia, severe infection, inflammation, trauma, or tumor, potentially leading to peritonitis, adhesions, sepsis, or organ failure.

### **Peritoneal Sac**

The peritoneal sac is the potential space enclosed by the peritoneum, containing lubricating fluid and allowing abdominal organs to move with minimal friction.

### **Peritoneum Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving peritoneum neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Perivitelline Space**

The perivitelline space is the narrow region between an egg's plasma membrane and surrounding vitelline or zona material, important in fertilization and early development.

### **Permease**

A permease is a membrane transport protein that facilitates movement of a specific molecule or ion across a cell membrane.

### **Permissiveness**

Permissiveness is the ability of a cell or host environment to allow a biological process, such as viral replication, gene expression, or tissue response, to occur.

### **Peroneal Nerve**

The common fibular nerve, a branch of the sciatic nerve that winds around the fibular neck and supplies sensation and muscles responsible for ankle dorsiflexion and eversion.

### **Peroxidase**

A medical term referring to peroxidase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Peroxisomal Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving peroxisomal disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Peroxisome Proliferation**

An increase in the number or size of peroxisomes, organelles involved in fatty-acid oxidation and reactive-oxygen metabolism, triggered by selected chemicals, hormones, or metabolic states.

### **Perseveration**

Involuntary repetition of a word, idea, movement, or response after the appropriate stimulus has changed, associated with frontal or basal-ganglia disease, aphasia, delirium, or psychiatric illness.

### **Persistent Cloaca**

Persistent cloaca is a congenital malformation in which the rectum, vagina, and urinary tract join into one channel, requiring specialist evaluation and reconstructive care.

### **Person**

A person is an individual human being; clinical care considers the person's biology, symptoms, preferences, capacity, relationships, and social circumstances.

### **Person Name**

A person name is an identifying name associated with an individual; accurate identification is essential for safe records, testing, prescribing, and communication.

### **Person With Disability**

A person with disability has a long-term physical, sensory, intellectual, or mental-health impairment that may interact with barriers to limit participation; care should be accessible and person-centered.

### **Personality**

Personality is the relatively enduring pattern of thoughts, emotions, motivations, and behaviors through which a person experiences and responds

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to the world.

### **Personality Change**

Personality change is a new or marked alteration in behavior, emotional responses, judgment, or interpersonal style, which may reflect neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, substances, or medical conditions.

### **Personality Test**

A psychological assessment using structured questions or stimuli to describe enduring traits, patterns, or possible personality pathology; results require validated instruments and clinical interpretation.

### **Persuasive Communication**

Communication intended to influence beliefs, decisions, or behavior through information, reasoning, emotion, or framing; healthcare use should preserve informed choice and avoid coercion.

### **Pertussis Toxin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pertussis toxin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pertussis Vaccine**

A medical term referring to pertussis vaccine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pertuzumab**

A medical term referring to pertuzumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pestalotiopsis**

A medical term referring to pestalotiopsis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Petechia**

A petechia is a tiny nonblanching red, purple, or brown spot caused by bleeding from small vessels into the skin or mucosa; numerous or rapidly spread-

ing petechiae need assessment.

### **Petri Dish**

A Petri dish is a shallow lidded laboratory container used to culture microorganisms or cells and to hold specimens or small samples.

### **Pexophagy**

Pexophagy is selective autophagic degradation of peroxisomes, allowing cells to remove damaged or excess organelles and recycle their components.

### **P-Glycoprotein**

An ATP-dependent membrane transporter encoded by ABCB1 that pumps many drugs and other compounds out of cells, affecting intestinal absorption, tissue penetration, and drug interactions.

### **PH Meter**

A medical term referring to ph meter. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Phagocytic Vesicle**

A phagocytic vesicle, or phagosome, is the membrane-bound compartment formed when a cell engulfs a particle before fusion with lysosomes for digestion.

### **Phagolysosome**

A phagolysosome forms when a phagosome fuses with a lysosome, exposing engulfed microbes or debris to enzymes and toxic substances for destruction.

### **Phagophores**

Phagophores are isolation membranes that expand around cytoplasmic material during autophagy and close to form autophagosomes.

### **Phalanx Unspecified**

A phalanx is one of the bones of a finger or toe; “unspecified” indicates that the particular digit or proximal, middle, or distal segment is not identified.

### **Phantom Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving phantom

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pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pharmaceutical Adjuvant**

A pharmaceutical adjuvant is an inactive or auxiliary ingredient added to improve a medicine's stability, absorption, preservation, delivery, or therapeutic effect.

### **Pharmaceutical Excipient**

A pharmaceutical excipient is a non-active ingredient in a dosage form, such as a filler, binder, coating, solvent, preservative, or disintegrant.

### **Pharmaceutical Solutions**

Liquid preparations in which one or more active pharmaceutical ingredients are dissolved in a suitable vehicle for administration, with concentration, sterility, stability, and route determining safe use.

### **Pharmacogenomic Testing**

Testing that examines genetic variants affecting drug metabolism, transport, targets, or adverse reactions to help select or dose certain medicines.

### **Pharmacologic Substance**

A pharmacologic substance is a chemical that produces a biological effect by interacting with cells, receptors, enzymes, transporters, or other targets.

### **Pharmacotherapy**

pharmacotherapy is used in relation to pharmacotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Pharmacy Facility**

A pharmacy facility is an authorized location where medicines may be stored, prepared, dispensed, monitored, and supplied under applicable professional and safety standards.

### **Pharyngeal Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving pharyngeal carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pharyngeal Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving pharyngeal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pharyngeal Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving pharyngeal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pharyngeal Mucositis**

Inflammation and ulceration of the throat lining, commonly caused by radiation, chemotherapy, infection, trauma, or medications and producing pain, difficulty swallowing, and reduced intake.

### **Pharyngeal Stenosis**

A clinical condition or finding involving pharyngeal stenosis. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pharyngectomy**

pharyngectomy is used in relation to pharyngectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Pharyngolaryngeal Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving pharyngolaryngeal pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pharynx Necrosis**

Death of tissue in the throat caused by severe infection, ischemia, radiation, caustic injury, or tumor, with risk of deep infection, bleeding, airway compromise, and sepsis.

### **Pharynx Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving pharynx neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Phase-Contrast Microscopy**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to phase-contrast microscopy. Results are interpreted with

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the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Phenacetin**

Phenacetin is a former analgesic and fever-reducing drug withdrawn or restricted because long-term use can cause kidney damage and increase cancer risk.

### **Phenazopyridine**

Phenazopyridine is a urinary analgesic that temporarily relieves dysuria without treating its cause; it can turn urine orange and prolonged or excessive use may cause haemolysis or methemoglobinaemia.

### **Phenethyl Isothiocyanate**

Phenethyl isothiocyanate is a sulfur-containing compound found in some plants and studied experimentally for antimicrobial and anticancer effects.

### **Phenethylamines**

Phenethylamines are a chemical family including neurotransmitters, medicines, and psychoactive substances that can affect adrenergic, dopaminergic, or serotonergic signaling.

### **Phenformin**

Phenformin is a former biguanide diabetes medicine withdrawn because it can cause life-threatening lactic acidosis.

### **Phenobarbital**

Phenobarbital is a long-acting barbiturate anti-seizure medicine that enhances GABA-A receptor inhibition; sedation, respiratory depression, cognitive effects, dependence, and enzyme-inducing drug interactions are important risks.

### **Phenocopy**

A phenocopy is a trait resembling an inherited phenotype but produced by an environmental exposure, disease, or other non-genetic cause.

### **Phenolphthalein**

A medical term referring to phenolphthalein. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Phenols**

A medical term referring to phenols. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Phenothiazine**

Phenothiazine is a chemical class that includes several antipsychotic and antiemetic medicines, with possible sedation, movement, and cardiac adverse effects.

### **Phenoxodiol**

Phenoxodiol is an investigational anticancer compound studied for effects on apoptosis and cellular signaling.

### **Phenprocoumon**

Phenprocoumon is a long-acting vitamin-K antagonist anticoagulant that reduces clotting-factor production and requires coagulation monitoring.

### **Phenthoate**

Phenthoate is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic poisoning after exposure.

### **Phentolamine**

Phentolamine is a short-acting alpha-adrenergic blocker used for catecholamine-related hypertension and to limit tissue injury after certain vasoconstrictor leaks.

### **Phenylacetate**

A medical term referring to phenylacetate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Phenylalanine**

A medical term referring to phenylalanine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Phenylbutyrate**

A medical term referring to phenylbutyrate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### Phenylpropanolamine

A biological or biochemical term involving phenylpropanolamine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Phenytoin Sodium

A medical term referring to phenytoin sodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Pheromone

A pheromone is a chemical signal released by an organism that alters behavior or physiology in another member of the same species.

### Phialemonium Atrogriseum

A medical term referring to phialemonium atrogriseum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Phialophora

A medical term referring to phialophora. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Phialophora Verrucosa

A medical term referring to phialophora verrucosa. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Phlebovirus

phlebovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Phonation

Production of voiced sound when exhaled air makes the vocal folds vibrate in the larynx; disorders cause hoarseness, weak voice, or loss of voice.

### Phorate

Phorate is a highly toxic organophosphate pesticide whose exposure can produce excessive cholinergic activity and medical emergency.

### Phorbol Ester

A phorbol ester is a plant-derived compound that activates protein kinase C and is used in research on inflammation, signaling, and tumor promotion.

### Phorbols

Phorbols are diterpene compounds related to phorbol esters that can activate cellular protein kinase C signaling.

### Phosgene

A highly toxic industrial gas that reacts with moist respiratory tissues and can cause delayed pulmonary edema, cough, chest tightness, and respiratory failure after exposure.

### Phosgene Oxime

A highly corrosive chemical warfare agent that causes immediate severe pain, skin and eye injury, airway damage, and tissue necrosis on contact.

### Phosmet

Phosmet is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after substantial exposure.

### Phosphamidon

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphamidon. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Phosphatidic Acid

A membrane phospholipid and signaling intermediate that serves as a precursor for other glycerolipids and influences membrane curvature, trafficking, and cell growth.

### Phosphatidylcholine

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphatidylcholine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Phosphatidylethanolamines

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphatidylethanolamines. Its role depends on the

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relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Phosphatidylinositol**

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphatidylinositol. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Phosphatidylserine**

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphatidylserine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Phosphatidylserines**

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphatidylserines. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Phosphine**

A biological or biochemical term involving phosphine. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Pigmentation Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving pigmentation disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pilocytic Astrocytoma**

Pilocytic astrocytoma is usually a slow-growing low-grade astrocytic brain tumor, often occurring in children and commonly involving the cerebellum or optic pathway.

### **Piloerection**

Elevation of hair shafts producing gooseflesh, caused by contraction of arrector pili muscles under sympathetic stimulation from cold, fear, pain, fever, or certain drugs.

### **Pilomatrixoma**

Pilomatrixoma is a usually benign skin tumor derived from hair-matrix cells, presenting as a firm subcutaneous nodule, often on the head or neck.

### **Pilonidal Fistula**

An abnormal tunnel from a pilonidal sinus to the skin, usually in the natal cleft, that can drain pus or recur after abscess formation.

### **Pilot Project**

A pilot project is a small preliminary implementation used to test feasibility, identify problems, and refine methods before broader rollout.

### **Pilus**

A pilus is a hair-like bacterial surface structure used for attachment, movement, or transfer of genetic material between cells.

### **Pinch Strength**

Pinch strength is the force produced when the thumb presses against one or more fingers and can help assess hand, nerve, muscle, and functional impairment.

### **Pindolol**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called pindolol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Pineal Cyst**

A pineal cyst is a fluid-filled lesion of the pineal gland, usually incidental and harmless but occasionally associated with headache, hydrocephalus, or visual symptoms.

### **Pineal Germinoma**

A pineal germinoma is a malignant germ-cell tumor in the pineal region, often causing headache, eye-movement abnormalities, or hydrocephalus and usually responsive to radiotherapy and chemotherapy.

### **Pineoblastoma**

A medical term referring to pineoblastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### **Pineocytoma**

Pineocytoma is a usually slow-growing tumor of pineal cells that may obstruct cerebrospinal-fluid flow and cause raised intracranial pressure.

### **Pinhole Meatus**

A pinhole meatus is an abnormally narrow external opening, commonly referring to the urethral meatus, that can obstruct urine flow or complicate catheterization.

### **Pioglitazone**

Pioglitazone is a PPAR-gamma agonist that improves insulin sensitivity in type 2 diabetes; weight gain, oedema, heart-failure worsening, fractures, and bladder-cancer concerns require patient-specific assessment.

### **Pipemidic Acid**

An older quinolone antibacterial formerly used mainly for urinary-tract infections; resistance and safety limitations have greatly reduced its clinical use.

### **Pipendoxifene**

Pipendoxifene is an investigational selective estrogen-receptor modulator studied for possible effects on breast, bone, and reproductive tissues.

### **Piperacillin**

Piperacillin is an extended-spectrum penicillin antibiotic often combined with tazobactam to treat serious infections including *Pseudomonas*; allergy, diarrhoea, cytopenias, electrolyte effects, and renal dosing are important.

### **Piperonyl Butoxide**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving piperonyl butoxide; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pipette**

A pipette is a laboratory instrument used to measure and transfer small volumes of liquid accurately.

### **Pipobroman**

Pipobroman is an oral alkylating antineoplastic drug used historically for some blood disorders and associated with marrow suppression and later cancer risk.

### **Pirfenidone**

Pirfenidone is an antifibrotic medicine used to slow decline in idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis; nausea, photosensitivity, fatigue, and liver-enzyme elevation may occur and require monitoring.

### **Pirimicarb**

Pirimicarb is a selective carbamate insecticide targeting aphids; exposure can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic symptoms.

### **Pirinitramide**

Pirinitramide is a synthetic opioid analgesic used historically in some countries; opioid effects include sedation, constipation, dependence, and respiratory depression.

### **Piritrexim**

Piritrexim is an investigational antifolate that inhibits dihydrofolate reductase and has been studied as an anticancer agent.

### **Piromidic Acid**

An older quinolone-like antibacterial investigated or used for urinary and gastrointestinal infections; current use depends on local availability, susceptibility, and safety guidance.

### **Piroxicam**

A medical term referring to piroxicam. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pisiform Bone**

A small pea-shaped carpal bone embedded in the tendon of flexor carpi ulnaris on the ulnar side of the wrist; fracture or arthritis can cause localized wrist pain.

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### **Pithomyces**

A medical term referring to pithomyces. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pituicytoma**

Pituicytoma is a rare typically slow-growing tumor arising from specialized glial cells of the pituitary stalk or posterior pituitary region.

### **Pituitary**

The pituitary is an endocrine gland at the base of the brain that releases hormones controlling growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, and water balance.

### **Pituitary Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving pituitary carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pituitary Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving pituitary disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pituitary Dwarfism**

Pituitary dwarfism is severe short stature caused by deficient growth hormone or broader pituitary dysfunction, with evaluation focused on endocrine and genetic causes.

### **Pituitary Hormone**

A hormone secreted by the anterior or posterior pituitary that regulates growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, water balance, or other endocrine organs.

### **Pituitary Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving pituitary neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pityriasis Lichenoides**

An uncommon inflammatory skin disorder producing recurrent small scaly papules, with forms

ranging from mild chronic lesions to an acute ulceronecrotic eruption.

### **Pivampicillin**

A medical term referring to pivampicillin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pixantrone**

Pixantrone is an anthracenedione antineoplastic drug developed for selected aggressive lymphomas, with potential marrow, infection, and cardiac risks.

### **Place**

Place describes a location or position; in healthcare, the relevant place may be an anatomic site, care setting, or environmental context.

### **Placebo Control**

A placebo control is an inactive treatment designed to resemble the intervention in a clinical trial, helping separate treatment effects from expectation and natural change.

### **Placenta Accreta**

Placenta accreta spectrum occurs when placental tissue abnormally attaches to or invades the uterine wall, creating major risk of hemorrhage during attempted delivery or removal.

### **Placenta Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving placenta disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Placenta Percreta**

Placenta percreta is the most invasive form of placenta accreta spectrum, with villi growing through the uterine wall and sometimes into nearby organs such as the bladder.

### **Placental Hormone**

A hormone produced by placental tissue, such as hCG, progesterone, estrogens, or human placental lactogen, that supports pregnancy, fetal growth, and maternal metabolic adaptation.

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### Placental Infarction

A region of placental tissue damaged by inadequate maternal blood flow and coagulation, which may be incidental or, when extensive, associated with fetal growth restriction or pregnancy complications.

### Placental Lactogen

Placental lactogen is a hormone made by the placenta that alters maternal metabolism and supports breast development and fetal nutrient availability during pregnancy.

### Placentation

The developmental process by which the placenta forms and attaches to the uterus, establishes maternal–fetal circulation, and develops the exchange and endocrine functions needed for pregnancy.

### Plagiocephaly

Plagiocephaly is asymmetric flattening or shaping of an infant's skull, caused by position or premature suture fusion; its evaluation distinguishes benign molding from craniosynostosis.

### Planococcaceae

Planococcaceae is a family of Gram-positive bacteria found in environmental habitats; clinical importance depends on the species and site of recovery.

### Planococcus Bacteria

planococcus bacteria is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Plant Development

Plant development is the progression from seed or meristem through growth, differentiation, flowering, reproduction, and senescence.

### Plant Extract

A plant extract is a preparation made by removing selected constituents from plant material; compo-

sition, dose, contamination, interactions, and evidence vary widely.

### Plant Oils

Plant oils are lipid mixtures extracted from seeds, fruits, or other plant parts and used as foods, medicines, cosmetics, or industrial materials.

### Plant Part

A plant part is a structural component such as a root, stem, leaf, flower, fruit, or seed that may contain distinct nutrients, chemicals, or medicinal constituents.

### Plant Poisoning

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving plant poisoning; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### Plant Proteins

Proteins supplied by legumes, grains, nuts, seeds, vegetables, and other plants; combining varied sources can provide essential amino acids, with nutritional needs depending on age and health.

### Plant Tumor

A neoplasm involving plant tumor. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Plant Virus

plant virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Plantar Nerve

A nerve supplying sensation to the sole of the foot and motor branches to intrinsic foot muscles; compression can cause burning pain, numbness, or altered toe movement.

### Plantaris Muscle

A small posterior-leg muscle with a long tendon

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that assists weakly with knee flexion and plantar flexion; it can be strained during sudden athletic movement.

### **Plasma Cell Neoplasm**

A clonal disorder of antibody-producing plasma cells, ranging from localized plasmacytoma to multiple myeloma with marrow, bone, kidney, calcium, or blood abnormalities.

### **Plasma Kallikrein**

A medical term referring to plasma kallikrein. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Plasma Membrane**

The selectively permeable lipid bilayer surrounding a cell, containing proteins that control transport, signaling, adhesion, recognition, and communication with the extracellular environment.

### **Plasma Substitutes**

A medical term referring to plasma substitutes. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Plasmablastic Lymphoma**

A neoplasm involving plasmablastic lymphoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Plasmalogen**

A medical term referring to plasmalogen. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Plasmid**

A plasmid is a small usually circular DNA molecule separate from a bacterial chromosome that can replicate independently and sometimes carries antibiotic-resistance genes.

### **Plasminogen**

Plasminogen is the inactive circulating precursor of plasmin, the enzyme that degrades fibrin; tissue or urokinase-type activators convert it to plasmin

during fibrinolysis.

### **Plasminogen Activator**

A plasminogen activator is an enzyme, such as tissue plasminogen activator or urokinase, that converts plasminogen to plasmin and promotes fibrin clot breakdown; therapeutic use carries bleeding risk.

### **Plasminogen Inactivators**

A medical term referring to plasminogen inactivators. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Plasmodesma**

A plasmodesma is a microscopic channel through a plant cell wall connecting neighboring cells and allowing controlled movement of molecules and signals.

### **Pleural Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving pleural neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Pleural Sac**

A biomedical term referring to pleural sac; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pleural Tuberculosis**

Tuberculous infection or inflammation of the pleura, often producing a lymphocyte-rich pleural effusion, chest pain, fever, and breathlessness and requiring microbiologic or tissue evaluation.

### **Pleuritic Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving pleuritic pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pleuropulmonary Blastoma**

A medical term referring to pleuropulmonary blastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **Plexiform Neurofibroma**

A plexiform neurofibroma is a diffuse nerve-sheath tumor, strongly associated with neurofibromatosis type 1, that can grow along multiple nerve branches and sometimes become malignant.

#### **Synonyms:**

PN PNF

### **Pliability**

Pliability is the ability of a material or tissue to bend, stretch, or deform without breaking; it is relevant to skin, vessels, lungs, and medical devices.

### **Plitidepsin**

Plitidepsin is an antineoplastic compound that targets eukaryotic elongation factor 1A and has been studied for selected cancers and viral infections.

### **Ploidies**

Ploidy describes the number of complete chromosome sets in a cell, such as haploid, diploid, or polyploid; abnormal ploidy can characterize tumors or developmental disorders.

### **Plozalizumab**

A medical term referring to plozalizumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pluralibacter Gergoviae**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pluralibacter gergoviae; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pluripotent Stem Cell**

A stem cell capable of producing derivatives of all three embryonic germ layers but not, by itself, a complete organism; embryonic and induced pluripotent stem cells are major research sources.

### **Pneumococcal Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pneumococcal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity,

and host response.

### **Pneumococcal Vaccine**

A medical term referring to pneumococcal vaccine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pneumocystis**

A medical term referring to pneumocystis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pneumocystis Carinii**

A medical term referring to pneumocystis carinii. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pneumocystis Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pneumocystis infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pneumocystis Jiroveci**

Pneumocystis jirovecii is a fungus that causes opportunistic pneumonia, especially in advanced HIV or other cellular immunodeficiency; symptoms include progressive dry cough, fever, and hypoxaemia, and diagnosis requires appropriate respiratory testing.

### **Pneumovirinae**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called pneumovirinae. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Pneumovirus**

pneumovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Pocket Erosion**

Loss of tissue at the margin or base of a periodontal or surgical pocket, potentially exposing deeper struc-

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tures and promoting infection, bleeding, or impaired healing.

### **Podocyte**

A podocyte is a specialized epithelial cell covering glomerular capillaries; injury to its filtration slits contributes to proteinuria and kidney disease.

### **Podofilox**

Podofilox is a topical antimitotic medicine used to treat selected external anogenital warts caused by human papillomavirus; irritation and correct application are important.

### **Podophyllin**

Podophyllin is a plant-derived resin with antimitotic activity formerly used topically for warts; it can be severely toxic if absorbed and is generally replaced by safer products.

### **Podosome**

A podosome is an actin-rich adhesion and matrix-degrading structure in cells such as macrophages and osteoclasts.

### **Poikiloderma**

A skin pattern combining mottled pigmentation, visible small vessels, and epidermal thinning, seen in connective-tissue disease, chronic sun damage, inflammation, and some cutaneous lymphomas.

### **Pokeweed Mitogen**

Pokeweed mitogen is a plant lectin used experimentally to stimulate lymphocyte proliferation and investigate immune-cell responses.

### **Pol Gene**

The HIV gene encoding enzymes required for viral replication, including protease, reverse transcriptase, and integrase; antiretroviral drugs target these products.

### **Polarography**

Polarography is an electrochemical analytical method that measures current while voltage changes

at an electrode to identify or quantify reducible substances.

### **Polidocanol**

Polidocanol is a detergent sclerosant injected to close selected varicose veins or vascular lesions by damaging the vessel lining and promoting fibrosis.

### **Poliosis**

A localized patch of white or depigmented hair caused by reduced melanin in follicles, occurring in vitiligo, alopecia areata, inflammatory disease, genetic syndromes, or after injury.

### **Poliovirus Vaccine**

poliovirus vaccine is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Pollakisuria**

Pollakisuria is unusually frequent urination, often in small amounts, caused by irritation, infection, stones, bladder disorders, anxiety, or other urinary conditions.

### **Pollen Tube**

A pollen tube is a tube grown by a germinating pollen grain that carries sperm cells through plant tissue to the ovule for fertilization.

### **Pollination**

Transfer of pollen from anthers to a receptive stigma or ovule, allowing fertilization in flowering plants; it is not a human reproductive process.

### **Poly A**

A medical term referring to poly a. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Poly I-C**

A medical term referring to poly i-c. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### **Poly ICLC**

A medical term referring to poly iclc. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyadenylation**

Addition of a polyadenosine tail to the 3' end of many eukaryotic messenger RNAs, promoting stability, nuclear export, and efficient translation.

### **Polyamine**

A medical term referring to polyamine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyamine Catabolism**

A medical term referring to polyamine catabolism. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polybrominated Biphenyl**

A medical term referring to polybrominated biphenyl. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polychlorinated Biphenyl**

A medical term referring to polychlorinated biphenyl. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyene**

A medical term referring to polyene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyethylene**

A medical term referring to polyethylene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polygenic Obesity**

Obesity arising from the combined effects of many genetic variants interacting with diet, activity, sleep, medications, and the wider environment rather than a single gene defect.

### **Polyglutamate Camptothecin**

A medical term referring to polyglutamate camptothecin. Its clinical meaning depends on the con-

text in which it is used.

### **Polygraphy**

polygraphy is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Polyketide Synthase**

A medical term referring to polyketide synthase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polylysine**

A medical term referring to polylysine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polymer**

A medical term referring to polymer. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polymerization**

Chemical joining of many small monomers into a larger polymer, a process important in biomolecules, plastics, dental materials, drug delivery, and laboratory techniques.

### **Polymyxin B**

A medical term referring to polymyxin b. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyneuritis**

Inflammation or injury affecting multiple peripheral nerves, causing symmetric pain, numbness, weakness, or autonomic dysfunction; causes include immune disease, infection, toxins, and deficiency.

### **Polynucleotide**

A biological or biochemical term involving polynucleotide. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Polyoma Virus**

polyoma virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical impor-

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tance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Polyomavirus Hominis 2**

polyomavirus hominis 2 is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Polyphenol**

A medical term referring to polyphenol. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyploid**

A medical term referring to polyploid. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polypropylene**

A medical term referring to polypropylene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyradiculopathy**

Disease affecting multiple spinal nerve roots, producing pain, weakness, sensory loss, or reflex changes in a distribution determined by the involved roots.

### **Polysome**

A medical term referring to polysome. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polysplenias**

A medical term referring to polysplenias. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polystyrene**

A medical term referring to polystyrene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polytene Chromosome**

An enlarged chromosome formed by repeated DNA replication without cell division, displaying visible bands and commonly used to study gene activity in insect tissues.

### **Polythiazide**

A medical term referring to polythiazide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyurethane**

A medical term referring to polyurethane. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polyvinyl**

A medical term referring to polyvinyl. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pomalidomide**

A medical term referring to pomalidomide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pontiac Fever**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pontiac fever; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Popliteal Cyst**

A fluid-filled swelling behind the knee, also called a Baker cyst, caused by communication between the joint and a bursa and often associated with arthritis, meniscal injury, or inflammation.

### **Population Density**

The number of people living in a defined area, a demographic measure relevant to crowding, resource needs, environmental exposure, and spread of communicable disease.

### **Population Genetics**

The study of how gene frequencies and genetic variation change within and between populations through inheritance, mutation, selection, migration, and genetic drift.

### **Population Group**

A defined set of people sharing a characteristic such as age, location, exposure, ancestry, occupation, or

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health condition for epidemiologic or clinical analysis.

### **Population Health**

The health outcomes of a defined group and the distribution of those outcomes, considered in relation to social conditions, environment, behavior, healthcare, and policy.

### **Porfimer Sodium**

A medical term referring to porfimer sodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porfiromycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called porfiromycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Porifera**

A medical term referring to porifera. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porin**

A porin is a channel-forming protein in an outer membrane, especially of Gram-negative bacteria, allowing passage of selected small molecules.

### **Porokeratosis**

A group of keratinization disorders producing characteristic ridge-like borders called cornoid lamellae around annular scaly lesions, with some forms carrying a small skin-cancer risk.

### **Poroma**

A poroma is a usually benign sweat-gland tumor presenting as a flesh-colored or reddish papule or nodule, often on palms or soles.

### **Porphyromonas**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porphyromonas Bennonis**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas bennonis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porphyromonas Catoniae**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas catoniae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porphyromonas Endodontalis**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas endodontalis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porphyromonas Levii**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas levii. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Porphyromonas Somerae**

A medical term referring to porphyromonas somerae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Portion Of Cytosol**

A region of the cell's aqueous internal fluid outside membrane-bound organelles, containing ions, metabolites, proteins, and enzymes that support cellular reactions.

### **Positive**

Positive means that a test, finding, result, or response is present or above a defined threshold; interpretation depends on the test and clinical setting.

### **Positive Finding**

A positive finding is an observed symptom, examination sign, image, laboratory result, or test response that supports the presence of a specified condition or feature.

### **Positron Camera**

A positron camera detects paired gamma rays from positron annihilation and is used in positron-

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emission tomography to map tracer distribution.

### **Postal Service**

A postal service transports letters, packages, specimens, or medicines; healthcare shipping requires appropriate packaging, labeling, temperature control, and privacy.

### **Posterior Rhinorrhea**

Posterior rhinorrhea is mucus draining from the nose into the throat, commonly causing throat clearing or cough from allergy, infection, irritation, or sinus disease.

### **Postganglionic Fiber**

An autonomic nerve fiber extending from a ganglion to its target organ after the synapse, carrying sympathetic or parasympathetic signals to smooth muscle, glands, or the heart.

### **Postnatal Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to postnatal care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Postoperative Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving postoperative hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Postoperative Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving postoperative infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Postoperative Period**

The postoperative period is the time after an operation when recovery, pain control, wound care, mobility, nutrition, complications, and follow-up are monitored.

### **Postprandial Period**

The postprandial period is the interval after eat-

ing when digestion and nutrient absorption occur and glucose, insulin, and other metabolic responses change.

### **Postsynaptic Membrane**

The specialized receiving surface of a neuron or muscle cell at a synapse, containing receptors and signaling proteins that respond to neurotransmitter released by the presynaptic cell.

### **Potassium Acetate**

A medical term referring to potassium acetate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Potassium Channel**

A medical term referring to potassium channel. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Potassium Chloride**

A chemical or physiological term involving potassium chloride. Its effects and clinical importance depend on its concentration, route of exposure, and patient context.

### **Potassium Citrate**

A chemical or physiological term involving potassium citrate. Its effects and clinical importance depend on its concentration, route of exposure, and patient context.

### **Potassium Cyanide**

A chemical or physiological term involving potassium cyanide. Its effects and clinical importance depend on its concentration, route of exposure, and patient context.

### **Potassium Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving potassium deficiency. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Potassium Dichromate**

A chemical or physiological term involving potas-

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sium dichromate. Its effects and clinical importance depend on its concentration, route of exposure, and patient context.

### Potassium Iodide

potassium iodide is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### Potassium Ion

The positively charged form of potassium, the principal intracellular cation that helps establish resting membrane potential, nerve transmission, muscle contraction, and cardiac rhythm.

### Potential

Potential describes a capacity, possibility, or stored energy that may become clinically relevant depending on circumstances and additional findings.

### Potentiometry

potentiometry is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### Povidone

povidone is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### Povidone-Iodine

povidone-iodine is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### Powder Diffraction

An analytical method that identifies crystalline substances by measuring how an X-ray or other beam is diffracted by powdered material.

### Poxviridae

poxviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Poxviridae Infection

poxviridae infection is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Ppar Alpha

PPAR-alpha is a nuclear receptor that regulates fatty-acid oxidation and lipid metabolism and is activated by fibrate medicines.

### Ppar Delta

PPAR-delta is a nuclear receptor involved in fatty-acid use, energy balance, inflammation, and tissue differentiation.

### Pracinostat

Pracinostat is an investigational histone-deacetylase inhibitor studied in myeloid and other cancers by altering gene expression and cell survival.

### Pragmatic Trial

A pragmatic trial evaluates an intervention under usual real-world care conditions to estimate how well it works in routine practice.

### Pralatrexate

pralatrexate is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### Pravastatin Sodium

pravastatin sodium is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

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### **Prealbumin**

Prealbumin, or transthyretin, is a liver-produced transport protein for thyroid hormone and retinol-binding protein; its level is influenced by inflammation and nutrition.

### **Precancerous Condition**

A neoplasm involving precancerous condition. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Precancerous Polyp**

A neoplasm involving precancerous polyp. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Precipitating Factor**

A precipitating factor is an event or exposure that triggers the onset or worsening of symptoms or disease in a susceptible person.

### **Preclinical Study**

preclinical study is a developmental, genetic, reproductive, or family-related term describing a stage, trait, relationship, or pregnancy history; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **Preconception Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to preconception care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Prediabetes Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving prediabetes syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Prednimustine**

Prednimustine is a former antineoplastic drug combining a corticosteroid-related group with an alkylating component and causing immunosuppression and marrow toxicity.

### **Prednisolone**

prednisolone is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Prednisone**

prednisone is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Preexcitation Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving preexcitation syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Prefix**

A prefix is a word element placed before a root to modify meaning; medical prefixes commonly indicate location, number, time, direction, or abnormality.

### **Prefrontal Cortex**

The prefrontal cortex is the front part of the frontal lobe involved in planning, judgment, working memory, impulse control, and social behavior.

### **Pregabalin**

pregabalin is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Preganglionic Fiber**

An autonomic nerve fiber that runs from the central nervous system to an autonomic ganglion, where it synapses with a postganglionic neuron.

### **Pregnancy Complication**

A maternal, fetal, placental, or labor-related problem that disrupts an otherwise expected pregnancy, such as preeclampsia, hemorrhage, diabetes, growth restriction, or preterm labor.



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## Pregnancy Outcome

Pregnancy outcome describes what happens to a pregnancy, such as live birth, miscarriage, stillbirth, preterm birth, or other maternal or fetal result.

## Pregnancy Status

Pregnancy status indicates whether a person is pregnant, not pregnant, or of unknown status and can affect medication, imaging, and treatment decisions.

## Pregnancy Trimester

A pregnancy trimester is one of three approximate stages of gestation used to organize fetal development, screening, risks, and clinical care.

## Pregnane

Pregnane is a 21-carbon steroid hydrocarbon that forms the structural backbone of progesterone and several corticosteroid and progestin compounds.

## Pregnanolone

Pregnanolone is a neuroactive steroid metabolite that can modulate GABA-A receptors and influence neuronal excitability, mood, and sedation.

## Pregnenolone

Pregnenolone is a steroid hormone precursor made from cholesterol that can be converted into progesterone, corticosteroids, and sex hormones.

## Premature Adrenarche

Early appearance of pubic or axillary hair, body odor, or mild acne from adrenal androgen production without true central puberty; evaluation excludes virilizing disorders.

## Premature Closure

Closure of a body opening, developmental structure, or growth plate earlier than expected, potentially causing obstruction, abnormal shape, or impaired growth depending on the site.

## Premature Labor

Regular uterine contractions with cervical change before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy, which can

lead to preterm birth and requires assessment of membranes, infection, and fetal well-being.

## Premature Thelarche

Isolated breast development in a young child without other signs of puberty, often transient but assessed for growth acceleration, estrogen exposure, or true precocious puberty.

## Pre-Medication

Medicine given before a procedure, treatment, or exposure to prevent a predictable problem such as pain, nausea, allergy, infection, or anxiety.

## Pre-MiRNA

A pre-miRNA is an early hairpin-shaped microRNA transcript processed in the nucleus before becoming a mature regulator of gene expression.

## Prenylation

Attachment of a lipid group to a protein, helping determine its membrane localization, signaling, stability, and interactions; abnormal prenylation contributes to some diseases and is a drug target.

## Preoperative Care

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to preoperative care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Preoptic Area

The preoptic area is a hypothalamic region involved in temperature regulation, sleep, reproductive behavior, and hormone control.

## Presenilin

Presenilin is a component of the gamma-secretase complex that processes membrane proteins; inherited variants can cause familial early-onset Alzheimer disease.

## Pressoreceptor

A pressure-sensitive receptor, especially a baroreceptor in the carotid sinus or aortic arch, that detects

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arterial stretch and helps regulate heart rate and blood pressure.

### **Presynaptic Terminals**

Presynaptic terminals are the ends of neurons that release neurotransmitters into synapses in response to electrical activity.

### **Primary Endpoint**

A primary endpoint is the main prespecified outcome used to judge the effect of an intervention in a clinical trial.

### **Primary Hypersomnia**

Excessive daytime sleepiness not better explained by insufficient sleep, another sleep disorder, substance, or medical condition; modern classification uses specific central-hypersomnolence diagnoses.

### **Primary Hypoparathyroidism**

Inadequate parathyroid hormone production causing low calcium and high phosphate, with possible tingling, cramps, tetany, seizures, cataracts, or chronic bone and dental effects.

### **Primary Hypothyroidism**

Reduced thyroid-gland production of thyroxine and triiodothyronine, usually causing high TSH and symptoms such as fatigue, cold intolerance, constipation, dry skin, and slowed heart rate.

### **Primary MicroRNA**

A primary microRNA is the initial RNA transcript made from a microRNA gene before nuclear and cytoplasmic processing into mature microRNA.

### **Primidone**

primidone is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Primitive Node**

The primitive node is an embryonic organizer at the cranial end of the primitive streak that helps

establish body axes and germ-layer formation.

### **Primitive Streak**

The primitive streak is an embryonic structure through which cells migrate during gastrulation to form the three germ layers and establish body organization.

### **Prinomastat**

Prinomastat is an investigational matrix-metalloproteinase inhibitor studied for blocking enzymes involved in tumor invasion and tissue remodeling.

### **Privacy**

Privacy is a person's right and expectation that personal information, communications, and bodily matters are protected from unauthorized access or disclosure.

### **Privacy Breach**

A privacy breach is unauthorized access, use, disclosure, loss, or exposure of personal or health information.

### **Probability**

Probability is a numerical expression of how likely an event is, ranging from impossible to certain and used in diagnosis, risk assessment, and research.

### **Probucol**

Probucol is a lipid-lowering drug that reduces cholesterol but may prolong the QT interval and is not widely used in current practice.

### **Procarbazine Hydrochloride**

Procarbazine hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt formulation of the antineoplastic drug procarbazine.

### **Procentriole**

A procentriole is an immature centriole that duplicates beside a parent centriole and later matures to organize microtubules.

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### **Procerus Muscle**

A small facial muscle over the bridge of the nose that draws the medial eyebrows downward and produces horizontal wrinkles between the eyebrows.

### **Processing Bodies**

Processing bodies are cytoplasmic RNA-protein granules where messenger RNAs may be stored, decapped, degraded, or regulated.

### **Processor**

A processor is a device or biological system that performs a defined sequence of operations; in computing it executes instructions, while in medicine the meaning is context-dependent.

### **Procollagen**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving procollagen. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Product Recall**

Removal or correction of a medicine, device, food, or other product because it may be defective, contaminated, mislabeled, or unsafe for use.

### **Proestrus**

Proestrus is the phase of the reproductive cycle before estrus, characterized by follicular development and rising estrogen in many mammals.

### **Progesterone Antagonist**

progesterone antagonist is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Progestin**

A progestin is a synthetic progesterone-like hormone used in contraception, hormone therapy, and treatment of selected gynecologic conditions.

### **Prognostic Factor**

A prognostic factor is a clinical, pathologic, or biologic feature associated with the likely course, out-

come, or survival of a disease.

### **Program Development**

Program development is the planned design, testing, implementation, and evaluation of a service, intervention, or software system.

### **Programmed Instruction**

A structured teaching method that presents small units of information with questions and immediate feedback, allowing learners to progress through material step by step.

### **Proinsulin**

proinsulin is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Projectile Vomiting**

Forceful vomiting expelled with unusual intensity, which may occur with gastric outlet obstruction, raised intracranial pressure, infection, migraine, or other causes; severity and associated signs guide evaluation.

### **Prokaryote**

A prokaryote is a cell or organism without a membrane-bound nucleus, including bacteria and archaea.

### **Prolactin Receptor**

A cell-surface receptor activated by prolactin to regulate mammary development, milk production, reproduction, immune effects, and other tissue responses.

### **Prolapsed Cord**

A prolapsed umbilical cord descends beside or ahead of the fetus after membrane rupture, risking cord compression and reduced fetal oxygen; it is an obstetric emergency.

### **Prolindac**

Prolindac is an investigational prodrug designed to

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release an active anticancer agent within tumors.

### **Prolymphocyte Count**

The number or proportion of prolymphocytes, immature-appearing lymphoid cells, in blood or marrow; an increased count may occur in selected lymphoid leukemias and requires morphology and immunophenotyping.

### **Prolymphocytic Leukemia**

A neoplasm involving prolymphocytic leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Promecarb**

Promecarb is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause cholinergic poisoning after substantial exposure.

### **Promegapoietin**

Promegapoietin is an investigational hematopoietic growth-factor molecule designed to stimulate production of blood cells or platelets.

### **Prometaphase**

Prometaphase is the stage of mitosis after nuclear-envelope breakdown when spindle microtubules attach to chromosome kinetochores.

### **Promethazine**

promethazine is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Promonocyte Count**

The number or proportion of promonocytes, immature monocyte precursors, in blood or marrow; increased cells may support evaluation of acute or chronic myeloid leukemia.

### **Promyelocytes**

Promyelocytes are immature myeloid blood-cell precursors that develop from myeloblasts and mature into myelocytes; abnormal accumulation occurs in

some leukemias.

### **Prone**

Prone means lying face downward with the front of the body against a surface; positioning affects breathing, pressure injury, and procedures.

### **Pronephric**

Pronephric refers to the earliest embryonic kidney system, which is temporary and helps organize development of later renal structures.

### **Propane**

Propane is a flammable hydrocarbon gas used as fuel; inhalation or displacement of oxygen can cause suffocation, and liquid contact can cause cold burns.

### **Propanol**

Propanol is an alcohol solvent with two structural isomers; ingestion or substantial exposure can depress the nervous system and irritate tissues.

### **Propellant**

A propellant is a gas or volatile substance that expels a product from a container or delivers medicine in an inhaler.

### **Properdin**

Properdin is a positive regulator of the alternative complement pathway that stabilizes complement convertase and supports innate immune defense.

### **Propetamphos**

Propetamphos is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Prophage**

A prophage is bacteriophage genetic material integrated into a bacterial chromosome or maintained in a dormant state inside a bacterium.

### **Prophase**

Prophase is the early stage of cell division when chromosomes condense, the spindle begins forming,

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and the nucleolus disappears.

### **Prophenofos**

Prophenofos is an organophosphate pesticide whose toxicity results mainly from acetylcholinesterase inhibition and excess cholinergic activity.

### **Prophylactic Mastectomy**

prophylactic mastectomy is used in relation to prophylactic mastectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Propiolactone**

Propiolactone is a reactive chemical formerly used as a disinfectant or sterilant; it is corrosive and potentially carcinogenic.

### **Propionates**

Salts or esters of propionic acid used in food preservation, metabolism, and some medicines; clinical effects depend on the specific compound and exposure.

### **Propionibacteriaceae**

propionibacteriaceae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Propionibacterium**

propionibacterium is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Propionibacterium Acnes**

propionibacterium acnes is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Propoxur**

Propoxur is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, breathing difficulty, or weakness after exposure.

### **Propoxycaine**

A medical term referring to propoxycaine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Propoxyphene**

Propoxyphene is a former opioid analgesic withdrawn in many countries because of overdose toxicity, respiratory depression, and dangerous cardiac arrhythmias.

### **Propylene Glycol**

A biological substance or process involving propylene Glycol; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Prosencephalon**

The prosencephalon is the embryonic forebrain, which develops into the telencephalon and diencephalon and their associated brain structures.

### **Prosoposchisis**

A rare congenital facial cleft or fissure caused by abnormal fusion of facial processes during embryonic development, potentially affecting the nose, mouth, eyes, and feeding or breathing.

### **Prostaglandin**

A locally acting lipid mediator derived from arachidonic acid that influences pain, inflammation, fever, vascular tone, platelet function, gastric protection, kidney function, and uterine contraction.

### **Prostaglandin Antagonist**

A drug that blocks a prostaglandin receptor or pathway, reducing selected prostaglandin-mediated effects such as inflammation, pain, uterine contraction, or gastric secretion.

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### Prostaglandin Degradation

Enzymatic inactivation and removal of prostaglandins, which limits the duration and intensity of their local effects on vessels, inflammation, smooth muscle, kidneys, stomach, and reproductive tissues.

### Prostaglandin Receptor

A membrane receptor that binds a specific prostaglandin and activates intracellular signaling controlling vascular tone, inflammation, pain, smooth muscle, platelet activity, or reproduction.

### Prostaglandins E

The E series of prostaglandins, lipid mediators that influence inflammation, vascular tone, gastric protection, kidney blood flow, cervical ripening, and uterine contraction.

### Prostaglandins F

The F series of prostaglandins, lipid mediators involved in smooth-muscle contraction, luteal function, vascular responses, inflammation, and labor-related uterine activity.

### Prostate Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving prostate carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Prostate Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving prostate disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Prostate Infection

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving prostate infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### Prostate Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving prostate neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Prostatic Fluid

Prostatic fluid is a mildly alkaline secretion that forms part of semen and contains substances supporting sperm function and survival.

### Prostatic Obstruction

A clinical condition or finding involving prostatic obstruction. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Prosthetic Heart Valve

An artificial valve replacing or supplementing a diseased cardiac valve; mechanical valves require anticoagulation, while tissue valves have different durability and anticoagulation considerations.

### Protanopia

Protanopia is complete absence of red-cone function, causing a form of red-green color-vision deficiency and altered perception of red and related colors.

### Proteaphagy

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving proteaphagy. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### Proteasome

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving proteasome. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### Proteasome Binding

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving proteasome binding. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### Proteasome Inhibitor

proteasome inhibitor is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### Protective Agent

A clinical or therapeutic concept involving protective agent. Its features, uses, and clinical signifi-



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cance depend on the relevant medical context.

### **Protegrin**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving protegrin. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Protein Acetylation**

Addition of an acetyl group to a protein, often changing its activity, localization, stability, or interactions; histone acetylation is a major regulator of gene expression.

### **Protein Biosynthesis**

Production of proteins by transcription of DNA into RNA followed by ribosomal translation of messenger RNA into an amino-acid chain.

### **Protein Deficiency**

Inadequate protein intake, digestion, absorption, or use, causing loss of muscle, impaired immunity and wound healing, edema, or growth failure when severe or prolonged.

### **Protein Denaturation**

Loss of a protein's normal three-dimensional structure from heat, chemicals, pH, or mechanical stress, often impairing its biological function without breaking its peptide backbone.

### **Protein Dephosphorylation**

Removal of a phosphate group from a protein by a phosphatase, often reversing or modifying signaling, enzyme activity, localization, or cell-cycle control.

### **Protein Engineering**

Design or modification of proteins through genetic, biochemical, or computational methods to alter activity, stability, specificity, expression, or therapeutic usefulness.

### **Protein Expression**

The process by which genetic information produces a protein, including transcription, RNA processing, translation, folding, modification, and cellular

localization.

### **Protein Glycosylation**

Enzymatic attachment of carbohydrate chains to proteins, affecting folding, stability, trafficking, recognition, and function; inherited glycosylation defects can cause multisystem disease.

### **Protein Import**

Transport of a protein into an organelle or across a cellular membrane using targeting signals, receptors, translocons, and energy-dependent folding or assembly mechanisms.

### **Protein Isoform**

One of several related protein forms produced from different genes, alternative splicing, or post-translational processing, with potentially different locations or functions.

### **Protein Kinase**

An enzyme that transfers phosphate from ATP to a protein, changing its activity or interactions and regulating signaling, metabolism, growth, differentiation, and cell division.

### **Protein Metabolism**

The synthesis, folding, modification, breakdown, and recycling of proteins and amino acids in cells and tissues.

### **Protein Methylation**

Addition of methyl groups to selected amino-acid residues, regulating protein activity, chromatin, signaling, and gene expression.

### **Protein Overexpression**

Production of an abnormally large amount of a protein, caused by gene amplification, transcriptional activation, altered degradation, or other mechanisms and potentially driving disease or serving as a biomarker.

### **Protein Phosphorylation**

Addition of phosphate to a protein by a kinase,

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a reversible switch that regulates enzyme activity, signaling pathways, gene expression, transport, and cell division.

### **Protein Prenylation**

Attachment of a hydrophobic isoprenoid group to a protein, helping target it to membranes and enabling signaling or trafficking functions.

### **Protein Purification**

Separation of a desired protein from cells or a mixture using properties such as charge, size, solubility, affinity, or binding, while preserving its structure and activity.

### **Protein Refolding**

Return of a denatured or newly synthesized protein to its functional three-dimensional structure, sometimes requiring chaperones or controlled laboratory conditions.

### **Protein Secretion**

Transport of a protein out of a cell or into a specialized compartment, commonly through the endoplasmic-reticulum and Golgi pathway or through regulated vesicle release.

### **Protein Sequence**

The ordered chain of amino acids in a protein, which encodes information about folding, domains, binding sites, processing, and biological function.

### **Protein Splicing**

Removal of an internal protein segment called an intein with ligation of the surrounding exteins, producing a mature functional protein.

### **Protein Subunit**

One polypeptide component of a multi-subunit protein complex, whose interactions with other subunits create the complex's final structure and function.

### **Protein Translocation**

Movement of a newly synthesized or mature protein across a membrane or to a different cellular compart-

ment, directed by targeting signals and transport machinery.

### **Protein Transport**

Cellular movement of proteins between compartments, across membranes, or outside the cell, ensuring that each protein reaches its functional location.

### **Protein Unfolding**

Loss of a protein's native three-dimensional structure, caused by heat, chemicals, mutations, or cellular stress, which can impair function or promote aggregation.

### **Proteinaceous Plug**

A blockage made primarily of protein-rich material, mucus, cellular debris, or secretions that can obstruct an airway, duct, catheter, or other passage.

### **Proteobacteria**

proteobacteria is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Proteogenomics**

Integration of genomic, transcriptomic, and proteomic data to identify proteins, discover coding variants, characterize tumors or microbes, and connect DNA changes with protein function.

### **Proteoglycan**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving proteoglycan. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Proteolipids**

Proteins tightly associated with lipid molecules or lipid membranes, important in myelin, mitochondrial membranes, ion transport, and other membrane structures.

### **Proteome**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving

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proteome. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Proteomic Profile**

proteomic profile is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Proteomics**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving proteomics. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Proteus Hauseri**

proteus hauseri is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Proteus Mirabilis**

proteus mirabilis is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Proteus Penneri**

proteus penneri is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Proteus Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving proteus syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Proteus Vulgaris**

proteus vulgaris is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Prothionamide**

A thioamide antimycobacterial drug used as part

of selected multidrug regimens for drug-resistant tuberculosis; gastrointestinal, hepatic, neurologic, and thyroid adverse effects require monitoring.

### **Protista**

Protista is a historical grouping for diverse mostly single-celled eukaryotes, including organisms formerly called protozoa and some algae.

### **Protocol Agent**

A protocol agent is a substance or intervention specified by a study or treatment protocol to produce a defined experimental or clinical effect.

### **Psychoacoustics**

The study of how people perceive and interpret sound, including loudness, pitch, masking, localization, speech, and hearing thresholds.

### **Psychobiology**

The study of interactions between biological processes and behavior or mental states, including brain circuits, hormones, genes, immune signals, and environmental effects.

### **Psychodidae**

A family of small hairy flies that includes sand flies; some species transmit pathogens such as Leishmania and therefore have public-health importance.

### **Psycholinguistics**

The study of how the brain and mind produce, understand, acquire, and remember language, including speech, reading, grammar, and meaning.

### **Psychological Adjustment**

The process of adapting thoughts, emotions, and behavior to stress, illness, disability, loss, developmental change, or other life circumstances.

### **Psychological Dependence**

A pattern in which a person feels a strong emotional or mental need for a substance or behavior, often with craving, preoccupation, or distress when it is unavailable.

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### **Psychological Transfer**

The redirection of feelings, expectations, or relationship patterns from earlier experiences onto another person, especially the therapist in psychotherapy; interpretation requires clinical context.

### **Psychomotor Agitation**

Restless, excessive, or purposeless movement associated with inner tension, anxiety, mania, delirium, depression, substance effects, or medication reactions.

### **Psychomotor Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving psychomotor disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Psychomotor Performance**

The ability to coordinate mental processing with physical movement, assessed through tasks involving speed, precision, reaction time, balance, or sequencing.

### **Psychoneuroimmunology**

The study of interactions among psychological processes, the nervous system, endocrine signals, and immune function in health and disease.

### **Psychophysics**

The quantitative study of relationships between physical stimuli and subjective sensory experience, such as thresholds, discrimination, and perceived intensity.

### **Psychophysiology**

The study of links between psychological processes and measurable bodily functions such as heart rate, skin conductance, muscle activity, and brain signals.

### **Psychosexual Development**

Development of sexual identity, interest, relationships, and behavior across the lifespan as influenced by biology, cognition, attachment, culture, and experience.

### **Psychotic Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving psychotic disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Psychotropic Drug**

psychotropic drug is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Psychrobacter**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving psychrobacter; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Psychrobacter Immobilis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving psychrobacter immobilis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pteridine**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pteridine. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pubertal Failure**

Failure to begin or progress through expected puberty because of hypothalamic, pituitary, gonadal, chromosomal, chronic-disease, nutritional, or other causes.

### **Public Assistance**

Government or community support providing eligible people with food, housing, income, healthcare, disability, or other essential services.

### **Publication**

A formally distributed written, electronic, or multimedia work that communicates research, evidence, education, policy, or other information.

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### **Puerperal Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving puerperal disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Puerperal Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving puerperal infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pulmonary Blastoma**

A medical term referring to pulmonary blastoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pulmonary Circulation**

The blood-flow circuit from the right ventricle through the pulmonary arteries and lung capillaries to the left atrium, where blood releases carbon dioxide and gains oxygen.

### **Pulmonary Compliance**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary compliance; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Fistula**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary fistula; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving pulmonary hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Pulmonary Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving pulmonary infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Pulmonary Mass**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary mass; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Nodule**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary nodule; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Reactance**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary reactance; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Trunk**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary trunk; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Valve Insufficiency**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary valve insufficiency; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonologist**

A pulmonologist is a physician specializing in diseases of the lungs and breathing system, including asthma, COPD, infections, and sleep-related breathing disorders.

### **Pulp Canal**

The pulp canal is the passage within a tooth root containing dental pulp, nerves, and blood vessels; infection may require root-canal treatment.

### **Pulp Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving pulp disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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### **Pulse Irregular**

An irregular pulse has uneven timing or varying beats and may reflect premature beats, atrial fibrillation, other arrhythmias, or measurement variation.

### **Pulse Radiolysis**

Pulse radiolysis is a research technique using short radiation pulses to create and study transient chemical species and reaction kinetics.

### **Pulse Rate**

Pulse rate is the number of palpable arterial beats per minute and usually approximates heart rate, although some arrhythmias produce a pulse deficit.

### **Pulvinar**

The pulvinar is the largest posterior nucleus of the thalamus and participates in visual attention, sensory integration, and connections with the cortex.

### **Puncture Biopsy**

Removal of a small tissue sample through a needle or puncture for microscopic, molecular, or microbiologic examination; imaging may guide the target and route.

### **Punicic Acid**

A conjugated polyunsaturated fatty acid found mainly in pomegranate seed oil and studied for lipid and inflammatory effects; clinical supplement benefits remain uncertain.

### **Punishment**

Punishment is a consequence intended to reduce a behavior; in healthcare, coercive or harmful punishment is inappropriate and behavior support should prioritize safety and dignity.

### **Purine Nucleosides**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving purine nucleosides. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Purine Nucleotides**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving purine nucleotides. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Purinoreceptor**

A purinoreceptor is a cell-surface receptor activated by extracellular purines such as ATP, ADP, or adenosine and involved in signaling, inflammation, and vascular control.

### **Purkinje Cell**

A large inhibitory neuron in the cerebellar cortex whose axons provide the sole output of the cerebellar cortex and regulate coordination, balance, and motor learning.

### **Puromycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called puromycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Purulent Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to purulent discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Putamen**

The putamen is a basal-ganglia structure involved in movement selection, motor learning, and habit-related behavior.

### **P-Value**

A p-value is the probability, under a specified null hypothesis, of observing results at least as extreme as those found; it does not by itself measure clinical importance.

### **Pycnodysostosis**

A rare autosomal-recessive bone dysplasia caused by CTSK deficiency, producing short stature, dense but fragile bones, acro-osteolysis, delayed closure of cranial sutures, and dental abnormalities.



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### **Pyloric Antrum**

The pyloric antrum is the lower stomach region that grinds food and regulates its passage toward the pyloric canal and duodenum.

### **Pyramidal Cell**

A triangular-shaped excitatory neuron with a prominent apical dendrite, found especially in the cerebral cortex and hippocampus and involved in long-range brain signaling.

### **Pyramidal Tract**

The pyramidal tract is a major motor pathway from the cerebral cortex to the brainstem and spinal cord that controls voluntary movement.

### **Pyrazines**

Pyrazines are aromatic nitrogen-containing chemical compounds found in foods, flavors, medicines, and industrial materials; effects depend on the specific compound and exposure.

### **Pyrazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called pyrazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Pyrazoles**

pyrazoles is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dose, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Pyrene**

Pyrene is a four-ring polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbon produced by incomplete combustion and used as an environmental marker of complex combustion mixtures.

### **Pyrenochaeta**

pyrenochaeta is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Pyridine**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyridine. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyridostigmine Bromide**

pyridostigmine bromide is a medicine or pharmacologic agent; its indication, dosing, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific product and patient.

### **Pyridoxal Phosphate**

A biological or biochemical term involving pyridoxal phosphate. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Pyrimidine Analog**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrimidine analog. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyrimidine Dimer**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrimidine dimer. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyrimidine Nucleosides**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrimidine nucleosides. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyrimidine Nucleotides**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrimidine nucleotides. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyrogen**

A pyrogen is a substance that induces fever, commonly through immune signaling; bacterial endotoxin is an important example in contaminated medicines or fluids.

### **Pyroglyphidae**

Pyroglyphidae is a mite family that includes house-dust mites whose allergens can trigger allergic rhini-

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tis, asthma, or atopic dermatitis.

### **Pyronine**

Pyronine is a red fluorescent dye used in histology and research to stain RNA and certain cellular components.

### **Pyrophosphatase**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrophosphatase. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyropoikilocytosis**

A severe inherited red-cell membrane disorder combining marked poikilocytosis, small irregular erythrocytes, thermal instability, and hemolytic anemia.

### **Pyroptosis**

A programmed inflammatory form of cell death involving gasdermin pores, cell swelling, membrane rupture, and release of cytokines, commonly triggered by intracellular infection or inflammasome activation.

### **Pyrosequencing**

pyrosequencing is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### **Pyroxamide**

Pyroxamide is an investigational histone-deacetylase inhibitor studied for anticancer effects through altered gene expression and cell growth.

### **Pyrroles**

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrroles. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

### **Pyrrolidonecarboxylic Acid**

A cyclic amino-acid derivative, also called pyroglutamic acid, found in proteins and metabolic pathways; abnormal accumulation may occur in selected

metabolic or medication-related conditions.

### **Pyrrolnitrin**

Pyrrolnitrin is an antimicrobial compound produced by some bacteria and studied for antifungal activity and biological control.

### **Pyruvate Decarboxylase**

Pyruvate decarboxylase is an enzyme that converts pyruvate to acetaldehyde and carbon dioxide during fermentation in some organisms.

### **Pyruvate Kinase**

Pyruvate kinase catalyzes the final ATP-producing step of glycolysis; inherited deficiency causes hemolytic anemia because red cells cannot generate enough energy.

### **Painful Urination (Dysuria)**

Pain, burning, or discomfort during urination, commonly caused by urinary infection, inflammation, stones, irritation, or sexually transmitted infection.

### **Peeling Skin**

Loss or shedding of the outer layer of skin, which may result from dryness, sunburn, irritation, allergy, infection, inflammation, or a systemic illness.

### **Protein In Urine (Proteinuria)**

An abnormal amount of protein in the urine, which may be temporary or indicate kidney disease, diabetes, high blood pressure, infection, or another condition.

### **PA/IVS**

Alternate index label; see *Pulmonary atresia with intact ventricular septum*.

### **PAES**

Alternate index label; see *Popliteal artery entrapment*.

### **Pain, Back**

Alternate index label; see *Back pain*.

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**Pain, Breast**

Alternate index label; see *Breast pain*.

**Pain, Chest**

Alternate index label; see *Chest pain*.

**Pain, Knee**

Alternate index label; see *Knee pain*.

**Pain, Neck**

Alternate index label; see *Neck pain*.

**Pain, Wrist**

Alternate index label; see *Wrist pain*.

**Painful Bladder Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial cystitis*.

**Painful Periods**

Alternate index label; see *Menstrual cramps*.

**Palsy, Bell's**

Alternate index label; see *Bell's palsy*.

**Palsy, Cerebral**

Alternate index label; see *Cerebral palsy*.

**Palsy, Facial**

Alternate index label; see *Bell's palsy*.

**Pancreas Inflammation**

Alternate index label; see *Pancreatitis*.

**PAPVR**

Alternate index label; see *Partial anomalous pulmonary venous return*.

**Paraneoplastic Neurological Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *Paraneoplastic syndromes of the nervous system*.

**Paraneoplastic Neurological Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Paraneoplastic syndromes of the nervous system*.

**Partial Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Connection**

Alternate index label; see *Partial anomalous pulmonary venous return*.

**Pathological Gambling**

Alternate index label; see *Compulsive gambling*.

**Pathological Laughter And Crying**

Alternate index label; see *Pseudobulbar affect*.

**Pathological Stealing**

Alternate index label; see *Kleptomania*.

**PBA**

Alternate index label; see *Pseudobulbar affect*.

**PDA**

Alternate index label; see *Patent ductus arteriosus (PDA)*.

**Pelvic Pain, Chronic**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic pelvic pain*.

**Pelvic Support Problems, Uterine Prolapse**

Alternate index label; see *Uterine prolapse*.

**Perforated Eardrum**

Alternate index label; see *Ruptured eardrum (perforated eardrum)*.

**Pericardial Inflammation**

Alternate index label; see *Pericarditis*.

**Periodontal Disease, Gingivitis**

Alternate index label; see *Gingivitis*.

**Periodontal Disease, Periodontitis**

Alternate index label; see *Periodontitis*.

**Peripheral Neurofibromatosis**

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

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**Pernio**

Alternate index label; see *Chilblains*.

**Peroneal Muscular Atrophy**

Alternate index label; see *Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease*.

**Personality Disorder, Antisocial**

Alternate index label; see *Antisocial personality disorder*.

**Personality Disorder, Borderline**

Alternate index label; see *Borderline personality disorder*.

**Personality Disorder, Narcissistic**

Alternate index label; see *Narcissistic personality disorder*.

**Personality Disorder, Schizoid**

Alternate index label; see *Schizoid personality disorder*.

**Personality Disorder, Schizotypal**

Alternate index label; see *Schizotypal personality disorder*.

**Pes Planus**

Alternate index label; see *Flatfeet*.

**Petit Mal Seizure**

Alternate index label; see *Absence seizure*.

**Phobia, Social**

Alternate index label; see *Social anxiety disorder (social phobia)*.

**PHT**

Alternate index label; see *Portal hypertension*.

**PID**

Alternate index label; see *Pelvic inflammatory disease (PID)*.

**Pilonidal Dimple**

Alternate index label; see *Sacral dimple*.

**Pimples**

Alternate index label; see *Acne*.

**Pituitary Insufficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Hypopituitarism*.

**Pituitary Neuroendocrine Tumor**

Alternate index label; see *Pituitary tumors and adenomas*.

**Pityriasis Versicolor**

Alternate index label; see *Tinea versicolor*.

**PJI**

Alternate index label; see *Periprosthetic joint infection (PJI)*.

**PJS**

Alternate index label; see *Peutz-Jeghers syndrome*.

**PKD**

Alternate index label; see *Polycystic kidney disease*.

**PKU**

Alternate index label; see *Phenylketonuria (PKU)*.

**Plantar Neuroma**

Alternate index label; see *Morton neuroma*.

**PLS**

Alternate index label; see *Primary lateral sclerosis (PLS)*.

**PMBCL**

Alternate index label; see *Primary mediastinal large B-cell lymphoma*.

**PMBL**

Alternate index label; see *Primary mediastinal large B-cell lymphoma*.

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**PN**

Alternate index label; see *Plexiform neurofibroma*.

**PNF**

Alternate index label; see *Plexiform neurofibroma*.

**Polyps, Colon**

Alternate index label; see *Colon polyps*.

**Polyps, Endometrial**

Alternate index label; see *Uterine polyps*.

**Polyps, Nasal**

Alternate index label; see *Nasal polyps*.

**Polyps, Stomach**

Alternate index label; see *Stomach polyps*.

**Polyps, Uterine**

Alternate index label; see *Uterine polyps*.

**Poor Color Vision**

Alternate index label; see *Color blindness*.

**Post-Cardiac Injury Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Dressler syndrome*.

**Post-Chemotherapy Cognitive Impairment**

Alternate index label; see *Chemo brain*.

**Posterior Prolapse**

Alternate index label; see *Posterior vaginal prolapse (rectocele)*.

**Postmyocardial Infarction Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Dressler syndrome*.

**Prader-Labhart-Willi Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Prader-Willi syndrome*.

**Pregnancy-Related Hypertension**

Alternate index label; see *Preeclampsia*.

**Premature Ovarian Failure**

Premature ovarian failure is loss of normal ovarian function before age 40, causing irregular or absent periods, infertility, and low-estrogen symptoms; causes may be genetic, autoimmune, toxic, or unknown.

**Premature Puberty**

Alternate index label; see *Precocious puberty*.

**Primary Adrenal Insufficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Addison's disease*.

**Primary Biliary Cirrhosis**

Alternate index label; see *Primary biliary cholangitis (PBC)*.

**Primary Polycythemia**

Alternate index label; see *Polycythemia vera*.

**Prolapse, Mitral Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Mitral valve prolapse*.

**Prolapsed Bladder**

Alternate index label; see *Anterior vaginal prolapse (cystocele)*.

**Prolapsed Uterus**

Alternate index label; see *Uterine prolapse*.

**Prostate Gland Enlargement**

Alternate index label; see *Benign prostatic hyperplasia (BPH)*.

**Pruritis Ani**

Alternate index label; see *Anal itching*.

**PTCL**

Alternate index label; see *Peripheral T-cell lymphoma*.

**Puffy Eyes**

Alternate index label; see *Bags under eyes*.

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## **PVCs**

Alternate index label; see *Premature ventricular contractions (PVCs)*.

## **PVD**

Alternate index label; see *Peripheral artery disease (PAD)*.

## **PVPS**

Alternate index label; see *Post-vasectomy pain syndrome*.

## **Paget Disease Of The Bone**

Paget disease of bone is abnormal remodeling that produces enlarged, weakened, or deformed bone and may cause pain, fractures, hearing loss, or nerve compression.

## **Pain And Your Emotions**

Pain and your emotions addresses care related to pain and your emotions, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Pain Medications - Narcotics**

Pain medications - narcotics addresses care related to pain medications - narcotics, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Painful Menstrual Periods**

Painful menstrual periods addresses care related to painful menstrual periods, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Painful Swallowing**

Painful swallowing addresses care related to painful swallowing, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Paint, Lacquer, And Varnish Remover Poisoning**

Paint, lacquer, and varnish remover poisoning in-

volves toxic or environmental exposure to paint, lacquer, and varnish remover poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Palatal Myoclonus**

Palatal myoclonus is rhythmic involuntary contraction of muscles of the soft palate, sometimes caused by lesions in brainstem motor pathways and producing clicking in the ear.

## **Palliative Care - Fear And Anxiety**

Palliative care - fear and anxiety addresses care related to palliative care - fear and anxiety, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Palliative Care - Fluid, Food, And Digestion**

Palliative care - fluid, food, and digestion addresses care related to palliative care - fluid, food, and digestion, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Palliative Care - Managing Pain**

Palliative care - managing pain addresses care related to palliative care - managing pain, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Palliative Care - Shortness Of Breath**

Palliative care - shortness of breath addresses care related to palliative care - shortness of breath, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Palliative Care - What The Final Days Are Like**

Palliative care - what the final days are like addresses care related to palliative care - what the final days are like, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.



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### **Palpebral Slant - Eye**

Palpebral slant - eye concerns palpebral slant - eye, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Pancreas Transplant**

Pancreas transplant involves toxic or environmental exposure to pancreas transplant; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pancreatitis - Children**

Pancreatitis in children is inflammation of the pancreas causing abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, and elevated pancreatic enzymes from structural, genetic, medication, infectious, or other causes.

### **Pancreatitis - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pancreatitis - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Panniculectomy**

Panniculectomy examines panniculectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pantothenic Acid And Biotin**

Two B vitamins involved in energy metabolism, fatty-acid synthesis, and other enzyme reactions; deficiency is uncommon but can occur with severe malnutrition, malabsorption, or specific inherited disorders.

### **Pap Test**

Pap test examines pap test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Para-Aminobenzoic Acid**

A folate-related compound used by bacteria in folate synthesis and formerly used in some medicines; humans do not require it as an essential vitamin.

### **Paradichlorobenzene Poisoning**

Paradichlorobenzene poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to paradichlorobenzene poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Paraffin Poisoning**

Paraffin poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to paraffin poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Paranoid Personality Disorder**

A clinical condition involving paranoid Personality Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Paraquat Poisoning**

Paraquat poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to paraquat poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Parathyroid Adenoma**

A parathyroid adenoma is a usually benign tumor of a parathyroid gland that can secrete excess parathyroid hormone and cause primary hyperparathyroidism with high calcium.

### **Parathyroid Cancer**

A neoplastic condition involving parathyroid Cancer; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Parathyroid Gland Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to parathyroid gland removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Parathyroid Hormone (PTH) Blood Test**

Parathyroid hormone (PTH) blood test examines parathyroid hormone (pth) blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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### **Parathyroid Hormone-Related Protein Blood Test**

Parathyroid hormone-related protein blood test examines parathyroid hormone-related protein blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Parinaud Oculoglandular Syndrome**

A biomedical term referring to parinaud oculoglandular syndrome; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Parkinson Disease - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to parkinson disease - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Parkinson Disease - Resources**

Parkinson disease - resources addresses care related to parkinson disease - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Paroxysmal Cold Hemoglobinuria (PCH)**

An autoimmune hemolytic anemia caused by a biphasic Donath–Landsteiner antibody that binds red cells in the cold and triggers complement-mediated destruction on rewarming.

### **Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria (PNH)**

Paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria (PNH) examines paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria (pnh); interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT)**

Paroxysmal supraventricular tachycardia is an abrupt-onset and abrupt-ending rapid rhythm arising above the ventricles, causing palpitations, dizziness, chest discomfort, or syncope.

### **Synonyms:**

PSVT (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT)) Supraventricular Tachycardia Paroxysmal (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT)) Tachycardia Paroxysmal Atrial (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT)) Tachycardia Paroxysmal Supraventricular (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT))

### **Partial Breast Brachytherapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to partial breast brachytherapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Partial Breast Radiation Therapy - External Beam**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to partial breast radiation therapy - external beam; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Partial Knee Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to partial knee replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Partial Thromboplastin Time (PTT)**

The partial thromboplastin time measures the intrinsic and common coagulation pathways and helps monitor unfractionated heparin or investigate bleeding and clotting abnormalities.

### **Patches**

Patches are flat, distinct areas of altered skin color larger than a macule; their appearance, distribution, and associated symptoms help identify the cause.

### **Patchy Skin Color**

Patchy skin color concerns patchy skin color, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

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### **Patent Urachus Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to patent urachus repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Patient Portals - An Online Tool For Your Health**

A secure electronic system allowing patients to view records, results, medicines, appointments, messages, and educational material and sometimes communicate with their care team.

### **PBG Urine Test**

PBG urine test examines pbg urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pectus Excavatum - Discharge**

Pectus excavatum - discharge examines pectus excavatum - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pectus Excavatum Repair**

Pectus excavatum repair examines pectus excavatum repair; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pediatric Heart Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pediatric heart surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pediatric Heart Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pediatric heart surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pediatric Sleep Apnea**

Pediatric sleep apnea is repeated interruption or reduction of breathing during sleep, commonly from

enlarged tonsils or adenoids, causing snoring, restless sleep, behavior changes, or impaired growth.

### **Pedicle**

A pedicle is a stalk or attachment containing vessels, nerves, or other supporting structures, such as the base of a polyp, flap, or vertebral arch.

### **PEG Tube Insertion - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to peg tube insertion - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pelvic CT Scan**

Pelvic CT scan examines pelvic ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pelvic Floor Muscle Training Exercises**

Pelvic floor muscle training exercises addresses care related to pelvic floor muscle training exercises, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Pelvic Inflammatory Disease (PID)**

Pelvic inflammatory disease is infection and inflammation of the upper female reproductive tract, often caused by sexually transmitted organisms and capable of causing infertility, ectopic pregnancy, or chronic pain.

**Synonyms:**  
PID

### **Pelvic Inflammatory Disease (PID) - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pelvic inflammatory disease (pid) - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pelvic Laparoscopy**

A medical term referring to pelvic laparoscopy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **Pelvic Radiation - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pelvic radiation - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pelvic Ultrasound - Abdominal**

Pelvic ultrasound - abdominal examines pelvic ultrasound - abdominal; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pelvis MRI Scan**

Pelvis MRI scan examines pelvis mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pelvis X-Ray**

Pelvis x-ray examines pelvis x-ray; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pencil Eraser Swallowing**

Pencil eraser swallowing involves toxic or environmental exposure to pencil eraser swallowing; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pencil Swallowing**

Pencil swallowing involves toxic or environmental exposure to pencil swallowing; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Penis Care (Uncircumcised)**

Penis care (uncircumcised) addresses care related to penis care (uncircumcised), including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Penis Pain**

Penis pain addresses care related to penis pain, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Pentazocine Overdose**

Pentazocine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to pentazocine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pentobarbital Overdose**

Pentobarbital overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to pentobarbital overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Peppermint Oil Overdose**

Peppermint oil overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to peppermint oil overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Peptic Ulcer Disease - Discharge**

Peptic ulcer disease discharge care addresses healing of a stomach or duodenal mucosal ulcer, medication adherence, bleeding warning signs, and avoidance of contributing irritants.

### **Percutaneous Kidney Procedures**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to percutaneous kidney procedures; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Percutaneous Transhepatic Cholangiogram**

A percutaneous transhepatic cholangiogram uses a needle through the liver to inject contrast into bile ducts for imaging and may guide drainage or stent placement.

### **Percutaneous Urinary Procedures - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to percutaneous urinary procedures - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Percutaneously Inserted Central**

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### **Catheter - Infants**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving percutaneously inserted central catheter - infants. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Perianal Streptococcal Cellulitis**

Perianal streptococcal cellulitis refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Pericardial Fluid Culture**

Pericardial fluid culture examines pericardial fluid culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pericardial Fluid Gram Stain**

Pericardial fluid Gram stain examines pericardial fluid gram stain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pericarditis - After Heart Attack**

A biomedical term referring to pericarditis - after heart attack; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pericarditis - Constrictive**

Pericarditis - constrictive examines pericarditis - constrictive; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Perichondritis**

Perichondritis is inflammation or infection of tissue surrounding cartilage, often affecting the outer ear after trauma or piercing and potentially damaging cartilage.

### **Periorbital Cellulitis**

Periorbital cellulitis refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal loca-

tion and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Peripheral Arterial Line - Infants**

Peripheral arterial line - infants concerns peripheral arterial line - infants, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Peripheral Artery Bypass - Leg**

Peripheral artery bypass - leg concerns peripheral artery bypass - leg, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Peripheral Artery Bypass - Leg - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to peripheral artery bypass - leg - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Peripheral Artery Disease - Legs**

Peripheral artery disease of the legs is atherosclerotic reduction in arterial blood flow causing exertional claudication, diminished pulses, nonhealing wounds, or critical limb ischemia.

### **Peripheral Artery Disease Of The Legs - Self-Care**

Self-care for leg arterial disease includes walking or supervised exercise, tobacco cessation, foot protection, prescribed medicines, and control of blood pressure, diabetes, and cholesterol.

### **Peripheral Intravenous Line - Infants**

Peripheral intravenous line - infants concerns peripheral intravenous line - infants, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter - Dressing Change**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving peripherally inserted central catheter - dressing

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change. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter - Flushing**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving peripherally inserted central catheter - flushing. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter - Insertion**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to peripherally inserted central catheter - insertion; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Perirenal Abscess**

A perirenal abscess is a collection of pus around the kidney, usually from spread of a urinary or kidney infection, causing fever, flank pain, and possible sepsis.

### **Peritoneal Fluid Analysis**

Peritoneal fluid analysis examines peritoneal fluid analysis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Peritoneal Fluid Culture**

Peritoneal fluid culture examines peritoneal fluid culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Peritonitis - Secondary**

Secondary peritonitis is infection of the abdominal lining caused by a perforated or injured gastrointestinal or other abdominal organ and may rapidly lead to sepsis.

### **Peritonitis - Spontaneous Bacterial**

Peritonitis - spontaneous bacterial examines peritonitis - spontaneous bacterial; interpretation de-

pends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Personality Disorders**

A clinical finding or condition involving personality Disorders; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Pesticides**

Pesticides involves toxic or environmental exposure to pesticides; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pesticides On Fruits And Vegetables**

Pesticides on fruits and vegetables involves toxic or environmental exposure to pesticides on fruits and vegetables; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **PET Scan For Breast Cancer**

PET scan for breast cancer examines pet scan for breast cancer; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Petroleum Jelly Overdose**

Petroleum jelly overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to petroleum jelly overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Petrositis**

Petrositis examines petrositis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pets And The Immunocompromised Person**

Pets and the immunocompromised person examines pets and the immunocompromised person; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pharmacogenetic Testing**

Pharmacogenetic testing examines pharmacogenetic



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testing; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pharyngitis - Sore Throat**

Pharyngitis is inflammation of the throat causing pain with swallowing, commonly from viral infection and sometimes from group A streptococcal infection or other causes.

### **Pharyngitis - Viral**

Viral pharyngitis is inflammation of the throat caused by a virus, commonly producing sore throat, cough, runny nose, or fever and usually resolving with supportive care.

### **Pharyngomaxillary Space Abscess**

A pharyngomaxillary space abscess is a deep infection containing pus near the pharynx and maxilla that can cause severe pain, swelling, difficulty swallowing, and airway risk.

### **Phencyclidine Overdose**

Phencyclidine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to phencyclidine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pheniramine Overdose**

Pheniramine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to pheniramine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Phenobarbital Overdose**

Phenobarbital overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to phenobarbital overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Phenothiazine Overdose**

Phenothiazine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to phenothiazine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Phenytoin Overdose**

Phenytoin overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to phenytoin overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Philodendron Poisoning**

Philodendron poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to philodendron poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Phobia - Simple/Specific**

A clinical finding or condition involving phobia - Simple/Specific; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Phonological Disorder**

A clinical condition involving phonological Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Phosphorus Blood Test**

Phosphorus blood test examines phosphorus blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Phosphorus In Diet**

Phosphorus in diet addresses care related to phosphorus in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Photodynamic Therapy For Cancer**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to photodynamic therapy for cancer; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Photographic Fixative Poisoning**

Photographic fixative poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to photographic fixative poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

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## Physical Activity

Physical activity examines physical activity; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Physical Exam Frequency

Physical exam frequency is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

## Physical Medicine And Rehabilitation

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to physical medicine and rehabilitation; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Physician Assistant Profession (PA)

A healthcare profession in which a trained, licensed clinician evaluates patients, diagnoses and treats illness, prescribes where authorized, and works with physicians within a defined scope of practice.

## Pin Care

Pin care addresses care related to pin care, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Pine Oil Poisoning

Pine oil poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to pine oil poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Pinworm Test

Pinworm test examines pinworm test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Pinworms

Pinworms are intestinal nematodes, *Enterobius vermicularis*, that cause nighttime anal itching; treatment, hand hygiene, and laundering help prevent household reinfection.

## Piperonyl Butoxide With Pyrethrins Poisoning

Piperonyl butoxide with pyrethrins poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to piperonyl butoxide with pyrethrins poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Piroxicam Overdose

Piroxicam overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to piroxicam overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Pityriasis Alba

Pityriasis alba is a common benign skin condition causing faint, dry, lighter patches, especially on children's faces, often more noticeable after tanning.

## Pityriasis Rubra Pilaris

Pityriasis rubra pilaris is an uncommon inflammatory skin disorder producing reddish-orange scaly plaques, follicular bumps, and areas of relatively normal skin.

## Placenta Abruptio

Placental abruption is premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall, causing bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fetal compromise, or maternal shock.

## Placenta Abruptio - Definition

Placental abruption is premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall before birth, causing bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, and possible fetal or maternal compromise.

## Placental Insufficiency

Placental insufficiency is inadequate placental delivery of oxygen and nutrients, which can cause fetal growth restriction, abnormal Doppler findings, reduced fluid, or fetal distress.

## Plant Fertilizer Poisoning

Plant fertilizer poisoning involves toxic or environ-

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mental exposure to plant fertilizer poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Plaque And Tartar On Teeth**

Dental plaque is a bacterial biofilm that forms on teeth, while tartar is hardened mineralized plaque; both contribute to cavities, gingivitis, and periodontitis.

### **Plasma Amino Acids**

Plasma amino acids concerns plasma amino acids, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Plastic Casting Resin Poisoning**

Plastic casting resin poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to plastic casting resin poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Plastic Resin Hardener Poisoning**

Plastic resin hardener poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to plastic resin hardener poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Platelet Aggregation Test**

Platelet aggregation test examines platelet aggregation test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Platelet Antibodies Blood Test**

Platelet antibodies blood test examines platelet antibodies blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Fluid Analysis**

Pleural fluid analysis examines pleural fluid analysis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Fluid Culture**

Pleural fluid culture examines pleural fluid culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Fluid Gram Stain**

Pleural fluid Gram stain examines pleural fluid gram stain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Fluid Smear**

Pleural fluid smear is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

### **Pleural Needle Biopsy**

Pleural needle biopsy examines pleural needle biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pneumococcal Conjugate Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to pneumococcal conjugate vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pneumococcal Meningitis**

A clinical condition involving pneumococcal Meningitis; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Pneumococcal Polysaccharide Vaccine (PPSV23) - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to pneumococcal polysaccharide vaccine (ppsv23) - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Pneumonia - Weakened Immune System**

A clinical condition involving pneumonia - Weakened Immune System; its causes, manifestations,

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severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Pneumonia In Adults - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pneumonia in adults - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pneumonia In Children - Community Acquired**

A clinical condition involving pneumonia In Children - Community Acquired; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Pneumonia In Children - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to pneumonia in children - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pneumothorax - Infants**

A clinical finding or condition involving pneumothorax - Infants; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Poinsettia Plant Exposure**

Poinsettia plant exposure involves toxic or environmental exposure to poinsettia plant exposure; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Point Tenderness - Abdomen**

Abdominal point tenderness is sharply localized pain when a particular abdominal site is pressed, which may indicate inflammation, infection, obstruction, or another focal process.

### **Poison Control Center - Emergency Number**

A poison-control center provides immediate expert advice after a possible poisoning or toxic exposure; the correct emergency number depends on the country and life-threatening symptoms require emer-

gency services.

### **Poison Ivy - Oak - Sumac**

Poison ivy, oak, and sumac cause allergic contact dermatitis through urushiol oil, producing intensely itchy red patches and blisters after skin exposure.

### **Poison Ivy - Oak - Sumac Rash**

A poison-ivy, oak, or sumac rash is itchy allergic contact dermatitis caused by urushiol, often appearing in streaks and spreading as exposed oil remains on skin or clothing.

### **Poisoning - Fish And Shellfish**

Poisoning - fish and shellfish involves toxic or environmental exposure to poisoning - fish and shellfish; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Poisoning First Aid**

Poisoning first aid involves toxic or environmental exposure to poisoning first aid; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Pokeweed Poisoning**

Pokeweed poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to pokeweed poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Polio Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to polio vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Polychromatophilia**

Polychromatophilia is bluish-gray staining of red blood cells on a blood smear, reflecting increased circulating immature reticulocytes from stimulated red-cell production.

### **Polycythemia - Newborn**

Neonatal polycythemia is an abnormally high red-cell concentration in a newborn that can increase

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blood viscosity and cause poor feeding, lethargy, breathing problems, or low glucose.

### **Polyendocrine Metabolic Ovarian Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving polyendocrine Metabolic Ovarian Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Polymorphous Light Eruption**

Polymorphous light eruption is an itchy inflammatory rash triggered by sunlight, usually appearing hours to days after exposure and recurring seasonally in susceptible people.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sun Poisoning

### **Polymyositis - Adult**

Adult polymyositis is an uncommon immune-mediated inflammatory muscle disease causing progressive symmetric proximal weakness and elevated muscle enzymes, after exclusion of mimics.

### **Polyp Biopsy**

Polyp biopsy examines polyp biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pompholyx Eczema**

Pompholyx, or dyshidrotic eczema, causes intensely itchy small blisters on the palms, sides of fingers, or soles and may leave painful peeling or cracks.

### **Porphyryns Blood Test**

Porphyryns blood test examines porphyryns blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Porphyryns Urine Test**

Porphyryns urine test examines porphyryns urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Portacaval Shunting**

A medical term referring to portacaval shunting. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Portion Size**

The amount of food or drink served or eaten at one time, distinct from a standardized serving size and important for estimating energy, carbohydrate, sodium, and nutrient intake.

### **Positioning Your Baby For Breastfeeding**

Placing an infant's head, neck, and body in alignment with the breast so the mouth opens widely, the latch is deep, and feeding is comfortable and effective.

### **Positive Airway Pressure Treatment**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to positive airway pressure treatment; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Post-Splenectomy Complications**

Post-splenectomy complications examines post-splenectomy complications; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Posterior Cruciate Ligament (PCL) Injury - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to posterior cruciate ligament (pcl) injury - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Posterior Fossa Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving posterior Fossa Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Postherpetic Neuralgia - Aftercare**

Postherpetic neuralgia - aftercare examines postherpetic neuralgia - aftercare; interpretation depends

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on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Poststreptococcal Glomerulonephritis (GN)**

Poststreptococcal glomerulonephritis is kidney inflammation occurring after certain streptococcal infections, causing blood or protein in urine, swelling, high blood pressure, and reduced kidney function.

### **Postsurgical Pain Treatment In Adults**

Postsurgical pain treatment in adults addresses care related to postsurgical pain treatment in adults, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Potassium Carbonate Poisoning**

Potassium carbonate poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to potassium carbonate poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Potassium Hydroxide Poisoning**

Potassium hydroxide poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to potassium hydroxide poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Potassium In Diet**

Potassium in diet addresses care related to potassium in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Potassium Test**

Potassium test examines potassium test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Potassium Urine Test**

Potassium urine test examines potassium urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Potato Plant Poisoning - Green Tubers And Sprouts**

Potato plant poisoning - green tubers and sprouts involves toxic or environmental exposure to potato plant poisoning - green tubers and sprouts; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Potbellies And Toddlers**

A rounded abdomen in a toddler is often normal body shape or posture, but persistent distension with pain, vomiting, poor growth, constipation, or a mass needs medical assessment.

### **Potential Acuity Meter**

Potential acuity meter is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation depends on the method and clinical context.

### **PPD Skin Test**

PPD skin test examines ppd skin test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pre-Existing Diabetes And Pregnancy**

Pre-existing type 1 or type 2 diabetes during pregnancy increases risks to parent and fetus, so glucose control, medicines, fetal growth, blood pressure, and eye and kidney health need coordinated care.

### **Preeclampsia - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to preeclampsia - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Pregnancy - Health Risks**

Health risks in pregnancy vary with medical conditions, medicines, infections, age, exposures, and obstetric history; prenatal assessment identifies preventable complications and needed monitoring.



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## **Pregnancy - Identifying Fertile Days**

Fertile days are the interval around ovulation when intercourse can lead to pregnancy; cycle timing, cervical mucus, basal temperature, and ovulation tests can provide estimates but are imperfect.

## **Pregnancy And Herpes**

Genital herpes during pregnancy can affect delivery planning and rarely infect the newborn; antiviral treatment and examination of lesions near labor help reduce transmission risk.

## **Pregnancy And The Flu**

Influenza during pregnancy can be more severe and affect the fetus; vaccination is recommended in pregnancy, and suspected illness should receive prompt clinical advice about antiviral treatment.

## **Pregnancy And Travel**

Travel during pregnancy depends on gestational age, health, destination infections, transport, and access to care; prevention includes vaccines as appropriate, food and water safety, movement, and medical planning.

## **Pregnancy And Work**

Work during pregnancy is usually possible but may require adjustments for heavy lifting, prolonged standing, heat, chemicals, radiation, infection, night work, or other occupational hazards.

## **Pregnancy Care**

Pregnancy care addresses care related to pregnancy care, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Premenstrual Breast Changes**

Premenstrual breast changes include cyclic fullness, tenderness, swelling, or lumpiness caused by hormonal variation; a persistent one-sided mass, skin change, or bloody discharge needs evaluation.

## **Premenstrual Syndrome - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to premenstrual syndrome - self-care;

indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Prenatal Care In Your First Trimester**

Prenatal care in your first trimester addresses care related to prenatal care in your first trimester, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Prenatal Care In Your Second Trimester**

Prenatal care in your second trimester addresses care related to prenatal care in your second trimester, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Prenatal Care In Your Third Trimester**

Prenatal care in your third trimester addresses care related to prenatal care in your third trimester, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Preparing Children For Pregnancy And A New Baby**

Preparing a child for a new baby involves age-appropriate explanation, routine and attention planning, safe involvement, reassurance, and support for emotional or behavioral changes.

## **Preparing For Surgery When You Have Diabetes**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to preparing for surgery when you have diabetes; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Preschooler Development**

Preschooler development includes rapid gains in language, motor skills, thinking, self-care, play, and social-emotional regulation; milestones vary, but loss of skills warrants assessment.

## **Preschooler Test Or Procedure Preparation**

Preschooler test or procedure preparation examines

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preschooler test or procedure preparation; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pressure Injuries - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Pressure injuries - what to ask your doctor examines pressure injuries - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Preventing Falls**

Fall prevention combines strength and balance activity, vision and medication review, safe footwear, adequate lighting, handrails, removal of hazards, and appropriate assistive devices.

### **Preventing Falls - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Preventing falls - what to ask your doctor examines preventing falls - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Preventing Food Poisoning**

Preventing food poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to preventing food poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Preventing Head Injuries In Children**

Children's head injuries can be reduced with age-appropriate car seats, helmets, supervision, safe play areas, window and stair protection, and prevention of abusive shaking or impact.

### **Preventing Hepatitis A**

Hepatitis A prevention relies on vaccination, hand-washing, safe food and water, sanitation, and post-exposure advice when close contact with an infected person occurs.

### **Preventing Hepatitis B Or C**

Hepatitis B prevention includes vaccination and avoiding blood or sexual exposure; hepatitis C

prevention centers on sterile injection equipment, screened blood, and testing and treatment of infection.

### **Preventing Infections When Visiting Someone In The Hospital**

Preventing infections when visiting someone in the hospital examines preventing infections when visiting someone in the hospital; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Preventing Pressure Injuries**

Pressure-injury prevention uses regular repositioning, skin inspection, moisture control, nutrition, pressure-redistributing surfaces, and minimizing friction and shear in people with limited mobility.

### **Preventing Stroke**

Stroke prevention includes controlling blood pressure, diabetes and cholesterol, avoiding tobacco, treating atrial fibrillation when indicated, exercising, and addressing other vascular risks.

### **Preventive Health Care**

Preventive health care addresses care related to preventive health care, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Primary Alveolar Hypoventilation**

A rare disorder of inadequate automatic breathing, often related to PHOX2B or other autonomic-control abnormalities, causing elevated carbon dioxide especially during sleep.

### **Primary Amyloidosis**

Primary amyloidosis, usually AL amyloidosis, results from abnormal plasma-cell proteins depositing as amyloid in organs such as the heart, kidneys, nerves, or gastrointestinal tract.

### **Primary And Secondary Hyperaldosteronism**

Excess aldosterone production, from an adrenal

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source in primary disease or from increased renin stimulation in secondary disease, causing hypertension, sodium retention, and sometimes low potassium.

### **Primary Lymphoma Of The Brain**

Primary central-nervous-system lymphoma is a lymphoma arising in the brain, spinal cord, eyes, or surrounding fluid without systemic disease at diagnosis.

### **Problems Sleeping During Pregnancy**

Sleep problems during pregnancy may result from discomfort, reflux, urination, anxiety, hormonal change, or sleep apnea; safe sleep habits and clinician-guided treatment are important.

### **Prochlorperazine Overdose**

Prochlorperazine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to prochlorperazine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Prognathism**

Forward projection of the upper or lower jaw relative to the facial skeleton, affecting bite, appearance, chewing, speech, and sometimes airway function.

### **Progressive Multifocal Leukoencephalopathy**

Progressive multifocal leukoencephalopathy is a potentially fatal demyelinating brain infection caused by JC virus reactivation during significant immune suppression.

### **Prolactin Blood Test**

Prolactin blood test examines prolactin blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Promethazine Overdose**

Promethazine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to promethazine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement

determine urgency and treatment.

### **Propane Poisoning**

Propane poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to propane poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Propyl Alcohol**

Propyl alcohols are flammable solvents; ingestion or substantial exposure can irritate tissues and depress the central nervous system, with toxicity depending on the isomer and dose.

### **Prostate Brachytherapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to prostate brachytherapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Prostate Brachytherapy - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to prostate brachytherapy - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Prostate Cancer - Resources**

Prostate cancer - resources addresses care related to prostate cancer - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Prostate Cancer Screening**

Prostate cancer screening addresses care related to prostate cancer screening, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Prostate Cancer Staging**

A biomedical term referring to prostate cancer staging; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

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### **Prostate Cancer Treatment**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to prostate cancer treatment; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Prostate Radiation - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to prostate radiation - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Prostate Resection - Minimally Invasive**

Prostate resection - minimally invasive examines prostate resection - minimally invasive; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prostate Resection - Minimally Invasive - Discharge**

Prostate resection - minimally invasive - discharge examines prostate resection - minimally invasive - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prostate-Specific Antigen (PSA) Blood Test**

Prostate-specific antigen (PSA) blood test examines prostate-specific antigen (psa) blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prostatitis - Bacterial**

Prostatitis - bacterial examines prostatitis - bacterial; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prostatitis - Bacterial - Self-Care**

Prostatitis - bacterial - self-care examines prostatitis - bacterial - self-care; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prostatitis - Nonbacterial**

Prostatitis - nonbacterial examines prostatitis - nonbacterial; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Prosthetic Graft**

A prosthetic graft is an artificial tube or patch used to replace or bypass a damaged blood vessel or other tubular structure; infection and thrombosis are important risks.

### **Protecting Yourself From Cancer Scams**

Protecting yourself from cancer scams examines protecting yourself from cancer scams; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Protein C Blood Test**

Protein C blood test examines protein c blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Protein Electrophoresis - Serum**

Protein electrophoresis - serum examines protein electrophoresis - serum; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Protein In Diet**

Protein in diet addresses care related to protein in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Protein S Blood Test**

Protein S blood test examines protein s blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Protein-Losing Enteropathy**

A biomedical term referring to protein-losing enteropathy; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or

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biologic context.

### **Prothrombin Deficiency**

Prothrombin deficiency is a rare bleeding disorder caused by insufficient or abnormal clotting factor II, leading to prolonged bleeding of variable severity.

### **Proton Pump Inhibitors**

Proton pump inhibitors suppress gastric acid secretion and treat reflux, ulcers, and other acid-related disorders; prolonged or inappropriate use should be periodically reviewed.

### **Protuberance**

A protuberance is a structure or area that projects outward from a surface, such as a normal bone prominence, swelling, or mass.

### **Provisional Tic Disorder**

A clinical condition involving provisional Tic Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Proximal Renal Tubular Acidosis**

A biological substance or process involving proximal Renal Tubular Acidosis; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Psoriasis - Resources**

Psoriasis - resources addresses care related to psoriasis - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Ptosis - Infants And Children**

Ptosis in an infant or child is drooping of the upper eyelid, which may obstruct vision or cause amblyopia and can reflect congenital, muscular, nerve, or other disease.

### **Puberty In Boys**

Puberty in boys is the hormone-driven development of testes, penis, body hair, voice, muscle, and fertility, usually progressing through predictable physical

stages.

### **Puberty In Girls**

Puberty in girls is the hormone-driven development of breasts, body hair, growth, menstrual cycles, and reproductive maturity, usually progressing through predictable stages.

### **Pubic Lice**

Pubic lice are parasitic insects infesting coarse body hair, causing intense itching and visible nits; treatment and assessment of close or sexual contacts are needed.

### **Pulling A Patient Up In Bed**

A safe repositioning technique using adequate staff, friction-reducing equipment, and coordinated movement to move a patient toward the head of the bed while preventing falls, shear, and staff injury.

### **Pulmonary Actinomycosis**

Pulmonary actinomycosis examines pulmonary actinomycosis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pulmonary Aspergilloma**

Pulmonary aspergilloma is a fungal taxon or fungus-related term; clinical interpretation depends on the species, site, host immune status, and evidence of invasive or superficial infection.

### **Pulmonary Embolus**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary embolus; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Hypertension - At Home**

Pulmonary hypertension - at home addresses care related to pulmonary hypertension - at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

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### **Pulmonary Nocardiosis**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary nocardiosis; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Veno-Occlusive Disease**

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary veno-occlusive disease; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Pulmonary Ventilation/Perfusion Scan**

Pulmonary ventilation/perfusion scan examines pulmonary ventilation/perfusion scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pulmonic Valve Stenosis**

Pulmonic valve stenosis is narrowing of the valve between the right ventricle and pulmonary artery, creating outflow obstruction and sometimes right-heart strain.

### **Pulse - Bounding**

A bounding pulse feels unusually strong or full and can occur with fever, anemia, hyperthyroidism, exercise, anxiety, aortic regurgitation, or high-output states.

### **Pupil - White**

A white pupil, or leukocoria, may result from reflection, cataract, retinal disease, infection, or retinoblastoma and requires prompt eye assessment, especially in a child.

### **Pustules**

Pustules are small raised skin lesions filled with pus, occurring in acne, folliculitis, infections, inflammatory disorders, or drug reactions.

### **Pyloric Stenosis In Infants**

Pyloric stenosis in infants examines pyloric stenosis in infants; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and

clinical question.

### **Pyogenic Liver Abscess**

A pyogenic liver abscess is a pus-filled infection in the liver, usually from biliary, abdominal, or bloodstream spread, causing fever, pain, and possible sepsis.

### **Pyruvate Kinase Blood Test**

Pyruvate kinase blood test examines pyruvate kinase blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Pagets Disease (Paget's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Paget's Disease.

### **Pain Cancer (Cancer Pain)**

Alternate index label for Cancer Pain.

### **Pain Elbow (Elbow Pain)**

Alternate index label for Elbow Pain.

### **Pain Gallbladder (Gallbladder Pain (Gall Bladder Pain))**

Alternate index label for Gallbladder Pain (Gall Bladder Pain).

### **Pain Heel (Heel Spurs)**

Alternate index label for Heel Spurs.

### **Pain Kidney (Kidney Pain)**

Alternate index label for Kidney Pain.

### **Pain Knee (Knee Pain Facts)**

Alternate index label for Knee Pain Facts.

### **Pain Lower Right Abdomen (Appendicitis)**

Alternate index label for Appendicitis.

### **Pain Management: Neuropathic Pain**

Neuropathic pain arises from injury or dysfunction of nerves and may feel burning, electric, shooting,



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numb, or hypersensitive. Treatment can include the cause-specific therapy, physical and psychological rehabilitation, topical agents, anticonvulsants, antidepressants, or specialist procedures.

**Synonyms:**

Neuropathic Pain (Pain Management: Neuropathic Pain)

**Pain Nerve (Neuropathic Pain (Nerve Pain))**

Alternate index label for Neuropathic Pain (Nerve Pain).

**Pain Scrotum (Testicular Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Testicular Disorders.

**Pain Stomach (Abdominal Pain (Causes, Remedies, Treatment))**

Alternate index label for Abdominal Pain (Causes, Remedies, Treatment).

**Pain Tailbone (Coccydynia)**

Alternate index label for Coccydynia.

**Pain Tooth (Toothache Overview)**

Alternate index label for Toothache Overview.

**Pain Vaginal (Vaginal Pain (Vulvodynia))**

Alternate index label for Vaginal Pain (Vulvodynia).

**Pain Whiplash (Whiplash)**

Alternate index label for Whiplash.

**Palm Sweating Excessive (Hyperhidrosis)**

Alternate index label for Hyperhidrosis.

**Palpitations Overview**

Palpitations are awareness of a racing, pounding, fluttering, or skipped heartbeat. They may result from normal stress, stimulants, anemia, thyroid disease, medicines, or arrhythmia; fainting, chest pain, breathlessness, or sustained rapid rhythm requires urgent assessment.

**Palsy Cerebral (Cerebral Palsy)**

Alternate index label for Cerebral Palsy.

**PAN (Polyarteritis Nodosa)**

Alternate index label for Polyarteritis Nodosa.

**Pancreas Inflammation (Pancreatitis)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatitis.

**Pancreas Inflammatory Cysts (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas IPMN (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Mucinous Cyst Adenomas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Non-Inflammatory Cysts (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Pseudocysts (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Serous Cyst Adenomas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Pancreas Solid Pseudopapillary Tumor (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

**Panniculitis Idiopathic Nodular (Weber-Christian Disease)**

Alternate index label for Weber-Christian Disease.

**Parenchymal Diffuse Lung Disease**

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**(Interstitial Lung Disease (Interstitial Pneumonia))**

Alternate index label for Interstitial Lung Disease (Interstitial Pneumonia).

**Parkinsons Disease (Parkinson's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Parkinson's Disease.

**Parkinsons Disease Diet (Parkinson's Disease: Eating Right)**

Alternate index label for Parkinson's Disease: Eating Right.

**Parotitis (Mumps)**

Alternate index label for Mumps.

**Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria (Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria PNH)**

Alternate index label for Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria PNH.

**Patchy Hair Loss (Alopecia Areata)**

Alternate index label for Alopecia Areata.

**PBC (Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC))**

Alternate index label for Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC).

**PCOS (Polycystic Ovary)**

Alternate index label for Polycystic Ovary.

**PDB (Paget's Disease)**

Alternate index label for Paget's Disease.

**Pemphigoid Bullous (Bullous Pemphigoid)**

Alternate index label for Bullous Pemphigoid.

**Penile Fibrosis (Peyronie's Disease (Curvature Of The Penis))**

Alternate index label for Peyronie's Disease (Curvature of the Penis).

**Penis Disorder (Priapism (Penis Disorder))**

Alternate index label for Priapism (Penis Disorder).

**Penis Disorder Balantis (Balanitis (Penis Disorder))**

Alternate index label for Balanitis (Penis Disorder).

**Pericardial Disease (Pericarditis)**

Alternate index label for Pericarditis.

**Perichondrial Hematoma (Cauliflower Ear)**

Alternate index label for Cauliflower Ear.

**Period Vs. Spotting (Spotting Vs. Period Differences)**

Alternate index label for Spotting vs. Period Differences.

**Periodic Paralysis Syndrome**

Periodic paralysis syndromes are rare inherited or acquired disorders causing episodic muscle weakness associated with abnormal potassium handling or thyroid disease. Attacks may follow rest after exercise, meals, or stress; ECG, potassium testing, and genetic or endocrine evaluation guide care.

**Periodontitis (Gum Disease)**

Alternate index label for Gum Disease.

**Peripheral Neuritis (Peripheral Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Peripheral Neuropathy.

**Peripheral Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

**Personality Disorder Antisocial (Antisocial Personality Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Antisocial Personality Disorder.

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### **Pes Planus (Flatfoot (Pes Planus))**

Alternate index label for Flatfoot (Pes Planus).

### **Peyronie's Disease (Curvature Of The Penis)**

Alternate index label for Curvature of the Penis.

### **PH (Pulmonary Hypertension)**

Alternate index label for Pulmonary Hypertension.

### **Pharyngit Contagious (Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious.

### **Pharyngitis (Sore Throat (Pharyngitis))**

Alternate index label for Sore Throat (Pharyngitis).

### **Phimosis And Paraphimosis (Penis Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Penis Disorders.

### **Phlebitis And Thrombophlebitis**

Phlebitis is inflammation of a vein, while thrombophlebitis includes a clot within the inflamed vein. Superficial disease causes localized pain and redness; deep-vein thrombosis can embolize to the lungs and is suspected with limb swelling, pain, or breathlessness.

### **Piles (Hemorrhoids (Piles))**

Alternate index label for Hemorrhoids (Piles).

### **Pilonidal Sinus (Pilonidal Cyst)**

Alternate index label for Pilonidal Cyst.

### **Pimples (Acne)**

Alternate index label for Acne.

### **Pinched Nerve Overview**

A pinched nerve is compression or irritation of a nerve root or peripheral nerve, causing pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or radiating symptoms. Causes include disc disease, narrowing, injury, or en-

trapment; progressive weakness or bowel or bladder change is urgent.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nerve Pinched (Pinched Nerve Overview)

### **Pinkeye Contagious (Is Pinkeye Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Pinkeye Contagious.

### **Pinky Broken Finger (Broken Finger)**

Alternate index label for Broken Finger.

### **Pinworm Infection**

Pinworm infection is an intestinal infestation by *Enterobius vermicularis*, causing nighttime anal itching, disturbed sleep, and sometimes abdominal or genital irritation. Treatment of the person and close household contacts, hygiene, and repeat dosing reduce reinfection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Infection Pinworms (Pinworm Infection) Worms Pinworms (Pinworm Infection)

### **PiriformSyndrome (Piriformis Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Piriformis Syndrome.

### **Pituitary Tumor (Prolactinoma)**

Alternate index label for Prolactinoma.

### **Pityriasis Rosea Gibert (Pityriasis Rosea)**

Alternate index label for Pityriasis Rosea.

### **Plague (Plague Facts)**

Alternate index label for Plague Facts.

### **Plague Facts**

Plague is an infection caused by *Yersinia pestis*, usually acquired from infected flea exposure or animals. Bubonic disease causes painful lymph nodes, while pneumonic disease can spread through respiratory droplets; prompt antibiotics and public-health action are essential.

#### **Synonyms:**

Plague (Plague Facts)

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**Plasmodium Infection (Malaria Facts)**

Alternate index label for Malaria Facts.

**Platelet Count Low (Thrombocytopenia (Low Platelet Count))**

Alternate index label for Thrombocytopenia (Low Platelet Count).

**Platelet Disorder - Immune Thrombocytopenia (ITP)**

Alternate index label for ITP.

**Pleural Effusion (Fluid In The Chest Or On Lung)**

Alternate index label for Fluid In the Chest or On Lung.

**Pleurisy Contagious (Is Pleurisy Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Pleurisy Contagious.

**Pleuritis (Pleurisy)**

Alternate index label for Pleurisy.

**PM (Polymyositis)**

Alternate index label for Polymyositis.

**PMDD (Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder (PMDD))**

Alternate index label for Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder (PMDD).

**PMR (Polymyalgia Rheumatica)**

Alternate index label for Polymyalgia Rheumatica.

**Poison Ivy, Oak, And Sumac**

Poison ivy, oak, and sumac cause allergic contact dermatitis through urushiol oil, producing intensely itchy streaks or patches of redness, blisters, and swelling. Washing exposed skin and clothing promptly helps; breathing difficulty or facial swelling is an emergency.

**Synonyms:**

Allergy Plant Contact (Poison Ivy, Oak, And Sumac)

**Poisoning Arsenic (Arsenic Poisoning)**

Alternate index label for Arsenic Poisoning.

**Poisoning Ciguatera (Ciguatera Poisoning)**

Alternate index label for Ciguatera Poisoning.

**Poisoning Thallium (Thallium)**

Alternate index label for Thallium.

**Polio Facts**

Polio is infection with poliovirus, which may be asymptomatic or cause meningitis, muscle weakness, paralysis, and respiratory failure. Vaccination is highly effective prevention; suspected disease requires urgent medical and public-health evaluation.

**Polycystic Ovary**

Polycystic ovaries contain many small follicles and may occur as a normal variant or with polycystic ovary syndrome. PCOS additionally involves ovulatory dysfunction, androgen excess, irregular periods, infertility, acne, or metabolic risk and requires clinical—not ultrasound alone—diagnosis.

**Synonyms:**

PCOS (Polycystic Ovary)

**Polycythemia (High Red Blood Cell Count)**

Alternate index label for High Red Blood Cell Count.

**Polyps Colon (Colon Polyps)**

Alternate index label for Colon Polyps.

**Polyps Rectal (Colon Polyps)**

Alternate index label for Colon Polyps.

**Polyps Uterus (Uterine Fibroids)**

Alternate index label for Uterine Fibroids.

**Popcorn Lung Bronchiolitis Obliterans**

Bronchiolitis obliterans is irreversible scarring and narrowing of small airways that can follow toxic inhalation, infection, transplantation, or autoimmune

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disease. It causes persistent cough and breathlessness with obstructive lung testing; exposure avoidance and specialist care are important.

### **Popliteal Cyst (Baker Cyst)**

Alternate index label for Baker Cyst.

### **Post-Nasal Drip (Chronic Rhinitis)**

Alternate index label for Chronic Rhinitis.

### **Pot Marijuana (Marijuana)**

Alternate index label for Marijuana.

### **Powassan Virus Disease**

Powassan virus disease is a rare tick-borne infection that can cause fever, headache, vomiting, confusion, seizures, meningitis, or encephalitis. Treatment is supportive, and prevention relies on avoiding ticks and removing them promptly.

### **PPD (Postpartum Depression)**

Alternate index label for Postpartum Depression.

### **Pregnancy Diet (Pregnancy: Your Guide To Eating Right)**

Alternate index label for Pregnancy: Your Guide to Eating Right.

### **Pregnancy Ectopic (Ectopic Pregnancy)**

Alternate index label for Ectopic Pregnancy.

### **Pregnancy High Blood Pressure (Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia)**

Alternate index label for Pregnancy: Preeclampsia and Eclampsia.

### **Pregnancy Planning (Preparing For Pregnancy)**

Alternate index label for Preparing for Pregnancy.

### **Pregnancy Tubal (Ectopic Pregnancy)**

Alternate index label for Ectopic Pregnancy.

### **Pregnancy Vs. PMS (PMS Vs. Pregnancy Differences And Similarities)**

Alternate index label for PMS vs. Pregnancy Differences and Similarities.

### **Pregnancy: Bleeding During The First Trimester**

First-trimester bleeding may occur with implantation, cervical changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, or other causes. Assessment uses symptoms, examination, serial pregnancy hormone testing, and ultrasound; heavy bleeding, severe pain, faintness, or shoulder pain is urgent.

### **Pregnancy: Pain Relief Options For Birth**

Labor pain relief may include breathing and movement, water, massage, nitrous oxide, intravenous medicines, epidural analgesia, or spinal anesthesia. Choice depends on labor stage, maternal and fetal status, contraindications, availability, and informed preference.

### **Pregnancy: Placenta Previa**

Placenta previa occurs when the placenta lies over or near the cervical opening and can cause painless bright-red bleeding, especially later in pregnancy. Digital vaginal examination is avoided until location is known; recurrent bleeding requires obstetric planning and sometimes cesarean delivery.

### **Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia**

Preeclampsia is new hypertension during pregnancy with proteinuria or organ dysfunction; eclampsia is the occurrence of seizures. Severe headache, visual symptoms, upper-abdominal pain, shortness of breath, or seizure requires emergency obstetric treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Eclampsia Pregnancy (Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia) Pregnancy High Blood Pressure (Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia)

### **Pregnant (Pregnancy Planning (Preparing For Pregnancy))**

Alternate index label for Pregnancy Planning (Preparing for Pregnancy).

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### **Premature Menopause (Medical Procedural Causes)**

Alternate index label for Medical Procedural Causes.

### **Premenstrual Syndrome (Menstrual Cramps And PMS Medication Guide)**

Alternate index label for Menstrual Cramps and PMS Medication Guide.

### **Prevention IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention)**

Alternate index label for Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention.

### **Priapism (Penis Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Penis Disorder.

### **Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC)**

Alternate index label for PBC.

### **Primary Biliary Cirrhosis Treatment (PBC)**

Alternate index label for PBC.

### **Primary Immunodeficiency Disease PID**

Primary immunodeficiency diseases are inherited disorders of immune development or function that cause unusual, severe, recurrent, or persistent infections and sometimes autoimmunity or inflammation. Evaluation may include blood counts, immunoglobulins, functional tests, and genetic testing.

#### **Synonyms:**

Deficiency Primary Immunodeficiency (Primary Immunodeficiency Disease PID)

### **Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis (PSC)**

Alternate index label for PSC.

### **Primary Vs. Secondary Progressive MS**

Primary progressive multiple sclerosis worsens from onset without clear early relapses, while secondary progressive MS follows an earlier relapsing course and later develops steady progression. Disability, MRI activity, relapses, and treatment response

guide management.

### **Profunda Miliaria (Heat Rash)**

Alternate index label for Heat Rash.

### **Prostate Inflammation (Prostatitis (Inflammation Of The Prostate Gland))**

Alternate index label for Prostatitis (Inflammation of the Prostate Gland).

### **Prostatic Carcinoma (Prostate Cancer)**

Alternate index label for Prostate Cancer.

### **Prostatitis (Inflammation Of The Prostate Gland)**

Alternate index label for Inflammation of the Prostate Gland.

### **Prostatitis Vs BPH Enlarged Prostate Gland**

Prostatitis is inflammation or infection of the prostate and may cause pelvic pain, painful urination, fever, or urinary symptoms. Benign prostatic hyperplasia is age-related prostate enlargement causing weak stream, hesitancy, and incomplete emptying without infection.

### **Proximal Neuropathy Diabetic (Diabetic Neuropathy)**

Alternate index label for Diabetic Neuropathy.

### **Pruritus (Itch)**

Alternate index label for Itch.

### **PSC (Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis (PSC))**

Alternate index label for Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis (PSC).

### **Psoriasis Of The Scalp (Scalp Psoriasis)**

Alternate index label for Scalp Psoriasis.

### **PSVT (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT))**

Alternate index label for Paroxysmal Supraventric-



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ular Tachycardia (PSVT).

### **Psychosis ICU (ICU Psychosis)**

Alternate index label for ICU Psychosis.

### **Psychotic Disorder Brief (Brief Psychotic Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Brief Psychotic Disorder.

### **Psychotic Disorders**

Psychotic disorders involve impaired reality testing, such as hallucinations, delusions, disorganized thought, or marked behavioral change. Causes include schizophrenia-spectrum illness, mood disorders, substances, medicines, neurologic disease, and medical illness; new psychosis requires prompt assessment and safety planning.

### **PTSD (Posttraumatic Stress Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Posttraumatic Stress Disorder.

### **Pugilistica Dementia (Dementia)**

Alternate index label for Dementia.

### **Pulled Hamstring (Hamstring Injury)**

Alternate index label for Hamstring Injury.

### **Pulmonary FibrosisIdiopathic (Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis (IPF))**

Alternate index label for Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis (IPF).

### **PVC (Premature Ventricular Contractions)**

Alternate index label for Premature Ventricular Contractions.

### **PVD (Peripheral Vascular Disease)**

Alternate index label for Peripheral Vascular Disease.

### **PXE (Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum)**

Alternate index label for Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum.

### **P Arm Of A Chromosome**

The short arm of a chromosome, designated p for petit, opposite the longer q arm; cytogenetic locations are written with p-band coordinates.

### **P.C.**

P.C. is an abbreviation whose meaning depends on context; in medication instructions it commonly means after meals, while other clinical uses must be specified.

### **P.O.**

P.O. is the medication abbreviation for by mouth or orally; clear modern instructions should spell this out to prevent route errors.

### **P.R.N.**

P.R.N. means as needed, indicating that a medicine or intervention is used only when specified symptoms or circumstances occur within prescribed limits.

### **PA (Physician Assistant)**

A physician assistant is a licensed healthcare professional who evaluates patients, diagnoses and treats illness, prescribes where authorized, and works within a supervising or collaborative practice model.

### **PA X-Ray**

A PA X-ray is a posteroanterior radiograph, commonly of the chest, taken with the beam traveling from back to front to reduce heart magnification.

### **Pachy- (Prefix)**

A word-forming prefix meaning thick or thickness, as in pachyonychia, pachyderma, and pachycephaly.

### **Pachyderma**

Abnormal thickening and coarsening of the skin, which may occur with chronic inflammation, lymphedema, endocrine disease, or pachydermoperiostosis.

### **Paget Disease**

A clinical condition involving paget Disease; its

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causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Pain Unit**

A clinical service specializing in assessment and treatment of acute, chronic, cancer, neuropathic, or procedural pain using medicines, procedures, rehabilitation, and psychological care.

### **Painful Urination**

Dysuria, or pain, burning, or discomfort during urination, commonly caused by urinary infection, urethritis, stones, irritation, or inflammatory genital disease.

### **Paleostriatum**

The paleostriatum is a historical or comparative-anatomy term for a forebrain basal-ganglia region involved in motor control, corresponding in part to mammalian pallidal structures.

### **Palindrome**

A palindrome is a word or sequence that reads the same forward and backward; in genetics, palindromic DNA sequences can have specialized structural or recognition roles.

### **Palliative Treatment**

Palliative treatment is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Palmitate**

Palmitate is the salt or ester form of palmitic acid and participates in fatty-acid metabolism, lipid storage, and protein modification.

### **Palpitations**

The conscious sensation of the heartbeat as pounding, racing, fluttering, or skipping, caused by normal beats, arrhythmias, stimulants, anxiety, anemia, thyroid disease, or other conditions.

### **Panic**

Panic is sudden intense fear or distress with autonomic symptoms such as racing heart, sweating, trembling, breathlessness, or a sense of impending danger.

### **Panniculus**

A panniculus is a fold or layer of subcutaneous fatty tissue, especially the lower abdominal apron that may overhang the pubic region.

### **PAP**

PAP is an abbreviation with context-dependent meanings, including Papanicolaou testing, pulmonary alveolar proteinosis, or prostatic acid phosphatase; the full term should be specified.

### **Para**

Para- is a prefix meaning beside, beyond, abnormal, or related to childbirth depending on the word; its exact meaning must be read in context.

### **Para- (Prefix)**

Para- is a medical prefix whose meaning varies by use, including beside, beyond, abnormal, or the number of births reaching a specified gestational age.

### **Parainfectious**

Parainfectious describes a condition occurring during or around an infection, often from an immune response rather than direct invasion by the infectious organism.

### **Paralysis, Stomach**

Stomach paralysis, or gastroparesis, is delayed gastric emptying without a mechanical blockage, causing early fullness, nausea, vomiting, bloating, and variable glucose control.

### **Parasitic**

Parasitic means relating to an organism that lives in or on a host and obtains nutrients at the host's expense, sometimes causing disease.

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### **Parasitic Worm**

A parasitic worm is a helminth that lives in a host; human infection may involve the intestine, blood, lymphatics, lungs, liver, or tissues.

### **Parasitosis**

Infestation or infection by a parasite; the term may describe a confirmed parasitic disease or, in delusional parasitosis, a fixed false belief of infestation without evidence.

### **Paraskevidekatriaphobia**

An excessive fear of Friday the 13th, a specific situational phobia when it causes marked distress, avoidance, or impairment.

### **Parasomnia**

A parasomnia is an undesirable movement, behavior, emotion, or experience occurring during sleep or transitions between sleep and wakefulness.

### **Parasuicide**

Parasuicide is an older term for a suicide attempt or intentional self-harm without fatal outcome; current assessment focuses on self-harm, intent, safety, and urgent support.

### **Parathyroid Gland**

Parathyroid gland refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Parenchymal**

Parenchymal means relating to the functional cells of an organ, distinguished from its supporting connective tissue, vessels, and framework.

### **Parentectomy**

Parentectomy is surgical removal of a parent or source structure, such as the parent vessel or lesion, and its precise meaning depends on the procedure.

### **Parenteral**

Parenteral means delivered by a route other than the gastrointestinal tract, commonly by injection

or infusion such as intravenous, intramuscular, or subcutaneous administration.

### **Parietal Pericardium**

A biomedical term referring to parietal pericardium; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Paroxysmal Atrial Tachycardia**

Sudden episodes of rapid, regular atrial rhythm that start and stop abruptly, often producing palpitations, lightheadedness, chest discomfort, or shortness of breath.

### **Partial Seizure**

A seizure beginning in a localized region of one cerebral hemisphere, now called a focal seizure, with symptoms determined by the involved network and awareness either preserved or impaired.

### **Parturition**

The process of childbirth, including cervical ripening, labor contractions, delivery of the fetus, and expulsion of the placenta.

### **PAS**

PAS is an abbreviation that may mean periodic-acid-Schiff staining, para-aminosalicylic acid, or pulmonary-artery systolic pressure; context determines the meaning.

### **Passive Exercise**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to passive exercise; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **PAT**

PAT is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to paroxysmal atrial tachycardia, a rapid rhythm beginning in the atria, or another clinical term.

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### **Patellofemoral Syndrome (PFS)**

A clinical condition involving patellofemoral Syndrome (PFS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Patent (Adjective)**

Patent means open, unobstructed, or functioning, as in a patent airway, vessel, duct, or congenital fetal channel.

### **Patent (Noun)**

A patent is a legal grant giving an inventor defined rights over an invention for a limited period, subject to applicable law.

### **Patho-**

The term Patho- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Pathogenic**

Pathogenic means capable of causing disease in a susceptible host; pathogenicity depends on the organism or factor, dose, route, and host defenses.

### **Pathologic**

Pathologic means related to disease or an abnormal structural or functional change, rather than normal anatomy or physiology.

### **Pathy**

A suffix meaning disease, disorder, or abnormality, as in neuropathy, cardiomyopathy, and nephropathy.

### **Patient Autonomy**

A patient's right and capacity to make informed voluntary decisions about healthcare after receiving understandable information about options, benefits, risks, and alternatives.

### **Pavlov Pouch**

A Pavlov pouch is a surgically created isolated stomach pouch used in experimental physiology to study gastric secretion and neural control.

### **PCA**

PCA is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly meaning patient-controlled analgesia, in which a patient activates prescribed doses from an infusion device.

### **PCBs**

PCBs, or polychlorinated biphenyls, are persistent industrial chemicals that accumulate in tissues and can affect the nervous, endocrine, immune, and reproductive systems.

### **PCO**

PCO may mean polycystic ovaries or posterior capsular opacification; the intended condition depends on the clinical context.

### **PCO Disease**

A clinical condition involving pCO Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **PCT**

PCT is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean procalcitonin, porphyria cutanea tarda, or patient-care technician; the full term should be specified.

### **PDR**

PDR commonly means Physicians' Desk Reference, a drug-information reference, but the abbreviation has other uses and should be interpreted in context.

### **Pediatric**

Pediatric means relating to the medical care of infants, children, and adolescents, whose anatomy, physiology, development, and medication needs differ from adults.

### **Pedophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of children or infants that causes distress, avoidance, or impairment and may be classified as a specific phobia when clinically significant.

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## PEEP

PEEP, or positive end-expiratory pressure, is pressure maintained in the airways at the end of exhalation during mechanical ventilation to prevent alveolar collapse.

## Peeping Tom

Peeping tom is a nonclinical term for a person who secretly observes others, often for sexual gratification; assessment focuses on consent, harm, and safety.

## PEF

PEF, or peak expiratory flow, is the fastest airflow produced during a forceful exhalation and is used chiefly to monitor variable airway obstruction such as asthma.

## PEG

A pharmacologic agent associated with pEG; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

## Peliosis Hepatis

Blood-filled cyst-like spaces within the liver, associated with medicines, toxins, infection, malignancy, or systemic disease and occasionally complicated by liver failure or rupture.

## Pelvic

A biomedical term referring to pelvic; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Penile

Penile means relating to the penis, the external male organ involved in urination and sexual reproduction.

## Penis, Erection Of The

Penile rigidity produced by increased arterial inflow and reduced venous outflow after sexual or reflex stimulation; persistent difficulty is erectile dysfunction.

## Penis, Small

A penis that is substantially below expected stretched length for age, usually assessed as micropenis in a newborn or child after excluding measurement and developmental variation.

## PEP

PEP is a context-dependent abbreviation, including post-exposure prophylaxis, a preventive medicine course after a possible infection exposure.

## Percentile

A percentile indicates the percentage of a reference population with a value below a measurement, such as height, weight, or test score.

## Percutaneous Nephrolithotripsy (PNL)

Percutaneous nephrolithotripsy removes or fragments kidney stones through a tract made through the skin into the kidney, usually for larger or complex stones.

## Perforated Bowel

A perforated bowel is a hole through the intestinal wall allowing contents to leak into the abdomen, causing peritonitis and potentially life-threatening sepsis.

## Peri-

The term Peri- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

## Periappendiceal

Periappendiceal means located around the appendix, as in inflammation, fluid, an abscess, or fat stranding near the appendiceal tissue.

## Pericardial

A biomedical term referring to pericardial; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Perinatal

Perinatal refers to the period around birth, conven-

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tionally including late pregnancy and the first days or weeks after delivery depending on the definition used.

### **Perinatal Transmission**

Transmission of an infection or condition from mother to infant during pregnancy, labor, delivery, or breastfeeding, as with HIV, hepatitis B, syphilis, or certain genetic and congenital disorders.

### **Perinatologist**

A perinatologist is an obstetrician specializing in high-risk pregnancy, fetal medicine, prenatal diagnosis, and complications affecting the pregnant person or fetus.

### **Periodic Abstinence**

Periodic abstinence is avoiding intercourse during estimated fertile days to reduce pregnancy likelihood; cycle timing is imperfect and does not prevent infections.

### **Periodic Breathing**

Periodic breathing consists of repeated cycles of shallow or absent breathing followed by deeper breaths, occurring in some infants, during sleep, or with neurologic or cardiopulmonary disease.

### **Perionychium**

The skin and soft tissue surrounding a fingernail or toenail, including the nail folds and nearby cuticle; infection or inflammation causes paronychia.

### **Perioperative**

Perioperative means relating to the period before, during, and after an operation, including preparation, anesthesia, recovery, and complication prevention.

### **Pes**

Pes means foot; it is also used in terms describing foot shape or deformity, such as pes planus or pes cavus.

### **Pestilence**

Pestilence is an old term for a severe, widespread, often fatal infectious disease outbreak; modern usage usually specifies the pathogen and epidemiologic event.

### **Ph.D.**

A Ph.D. is a doctoral research degree awarded after advanced study and an original dissertation; it does not by itself confer a clinical license.

### **Phago-**

The term Phago- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Pharmacologist**

A pharmacologist studies how medicines and chemicals act in living systems, including mechanisms, metabolism, toxicity, and therapeutic effects.

### **Pharmacopoeia**

A pharmacopoeia is an official reference specifying standards for identity, purity, strength, testing, and preparation of medicines.

### **Phe**

Phe is the standard abbreviation for phenylalanine, an essential amino acid incorporated into proteins and metabolized through a pathway disrupted in phenylketonuria.

### **Pheresis**

Pheresis is removal of a selected component from blood by an apheresis machine while returning the remaining blood components to the donor or patient.

### **Phlebo- (Prefix)**

Phlebo- is a medical prefix meaning relating to a vein, as in phlebitis, phlebectomy, or phlebography.

### **PHS**

PHS is an abbreviation whose meaning depends on context, including public health service or primary



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hyperhidrosis; the full term should be specified.

### **Physical Child Abuse**

Physical child abuse is intentional physical injury or harmful force inflicted on a child, requiring immediate safety assessment, medical care, and safeguarding action.

### **Physician Assistant (PA)**

A physician assistant is a licensed clinician who examines, diagnoses, treats, and counsels patients within the scope of local law and a supervising or collaborative practice arrangement.

### **Physicians' Desk Reference**

A reference source containing prescribing information, indications, contraindications, dosing, warnings, and adverse effects for medicines and selected products.

### **Physiologic**

Physiologic means relating to normal body function or a process occurring within the expected biological range.

### **Physiologic Jaundice Of The Newborn**

A clinical finding or condition involving physiologic Jaundice Of The Newborn; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **PI**

PI is a context-dependent abbreviation, including principal investigator, pulmonary insufficiency, or protease inhibitor; the intended meaning must be specified.

### **Pigmentation**

Coloration of skin, hair, eyes, or other tissue produced mainly by melanin, carotenoids, blood, or exogenous material; abnormal changes may reflect inflammation, endocrine disease, drugs, or tumors.

### **Pisa Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving pisa Syndrome; its

causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Placenta, Succenturiate**

A succenturiate placenta has one or more accessory placental lobes separate from the main placenta, which can cause retained tissue or fetal-vessel complications after delivery.

### **Plan B**

Plan B is a levonorgestrel emergency contraceptive intended to reduce pregnancy risk after unprotected intercourse or contraceptive failure; it does not end an established pregnancy.

### **Plant Thorn Arthritis**

Plant thorn arthritis is persistent joint inflammation after a thorn puncture introduces plant material, sometimes requiring removal of foreign material and treatment of infection or inflammation.

### **Plantar Response**

A biomedical term referring to plantar response; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Plaque Psoriasis**

The most common form of psoriasis, producing well-demarcated raised red plaques with silvery scale, commonly on elbows, knees, scalp, and lower back and sometimes associated with arthritis.

### **Plasma Osmolarity**

A chemical or physiological term involving plasma osmolarity. Its effects and clinical importance depend on its concentration, route of exposure, and patient context.

### **Plegia**

-plegia is a suffix meaning paralysis, as in paraplegia, hemiplegia, or quadriplegia.

### **Pleiotropic Cytokine**

A cytokine that acts on multiple cell types or pro-

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duces several biological effects, such as changes in inflammation, blood formation, immunity, or tissue repair.

### **Pleomorphic**

Pleomorphic means having multiple forms or marked variation in cell or tissue appearance; in pathology, it may be a feature of malignancy but is not diagnostic alone.

### **Plethoric**

Plethoric means unusually full, congested, or ruddy, often describing the appearance associated with increased blood volume or red-cell mass.

### **Pleural**

A biomedical term referring to pleural; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **PLP**

PLP commonly means pyridoxal 5'-phosphate, the active coenzyme form of vitamin B6 required by many enzymes, but the abbreviation has other uses.

### **PMD**

PMD is a context-dependent abbreviation, including Pelizaeus–Merzbacher disease, a rare inherited disorder of central myelination, or a professional medical designation.

### **PMDD**

Premenstrual dysphoric disorder is a severe cyclic mood disorder occurring before menstruation with irritability, depression, anxiety, and functional impairment that improve after menses.

### **PML**

PML commonly means progressive multifocal leukoencephalopathy, a JC-virus demyelinating brain infection during severe immune suppression, but it may have other meanings.

### **Pneumo-**

The term Pneumo- is a medical word element or

prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Pneumonia, Bilateral**

A clinical condition involving pneumonia, Bilateral; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **PNS (Peripheral Nervous System)**

The peripheral nervous system includes nerves and ganglia outside the brain and spinal cord and carries sensory, motor, and autonomic signals between the body and central nervous system.

### **Polycystic Ovarian Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving polycystic Ovarian Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Polycythemia Vera (PV)**

Polycythemia vera is a myeloproliferative blood cancer, usually driven by a JAK2 mutation, causing excess red cells and increased risks of thrombosis, bleeding, and transformation.

### **Polygenic Disease**

A clinical condition involving polygenic Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Polyglandular Autoimmune Syndrome (PGA)**

A biomedical term referring to polyglandular autoimmune syndrome (pga); its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Polymorphic**

A clinical or therapeutic concept involving polymorphic. Its features, uses, and clinical significance depend on the relevant medical context.

### **Polymorphonuclear Leukocyte**

A white blood cell with a multilobed nucleus, especially a neutrophil, eosinophil, or basophil, involved

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in innate immune defense and inflammation.

### **Polymyalgia Rheumatica (PMR)**

Polymyalgia rheumatica causes abrupt bilateral shoulder and hip-girdle aching and stiffness in older adults and can occur with giant-cell arteritis.

### **Polyneuritis, Acute Idiopathic**

A clinical or therapeutic concept involving polyneuritis, acute idiopathic. Its features, uses, and clinical significance depend on the relevant medical context.

### **PON**

PON is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to postoperative nausea, paraoxonase, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be stated.

### **Poor Circulation**

Reduced or abnormal blood flow, usually referring to arterial insufficiency or venous disease, causing coolness, color change, pain, swelling, ulcers, or delayed wound healing.

### **Porcine**

Porcine means derived from or relating to pigs; porcine tissues, enzymes, and biologic products may be used in medicine after appropriate processing and screening.

### **Positive-Strand RNA Virus**

A positive-strand RNA virus has a genome that can function directly as messenger RNA in host cells, allowing translation soon after infection.

### **Post**

Post- is a prefix meaning after, as in post-operative, postpartum, or postprandial.

### **Posteroanterior**

Posteroanterior means directed from back to front; a PA chest radiograph uses this projection to reduce magnification of the heart.

### **Posthitis**

Inflammation of the foreskin, causing redness, swelling, itching, pain, discharge, or difficulty retracting it; infection, irritation, diabetes, and poor hygiene are possible contributors.

### **Postmenopausal**

Postmenopausal describes the period after menopause, when ovarian estrogen production and menstrual periods have permanently ceased.

### **Postop**

Postop is an abbreviation for postoperative, meaning relating to the period after a surgical procedure.

### **Postoperative**

Postoperative means occurring or provided after surgery, including recovery, wound care, pain control, rehabilitation, and complication monitoring.

### **Postprandial**

Postprandial means occurring after a meal, especially the changes in glucose, insulin, digestion, and circulation after eating.

### **Postural**

Postural means relating to body position or posture, including symptoms or vital signs that change when a person sits, stands, or lies down.

### **Pouch Of Douglas**

The pouch of Douglas is the peritoneal recess between the uterus and rectum, also called the rectouterine pouch, where fluid may collect.

### **Power Outage Food Safety**

A medical term referring to power outage food safety. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **PPD**

PPD may mean purified protein derivative used in tuberculosis skin testing or post-partum depression; context determines the intended meaning.

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## **Prandial**

Prandial means relating to a meal, as in preprandial before eating or postprandial after eating.

## **Precordial Catch Syndrome (PCS)**

A clinical condition involving precordial Catch Syndrome (PCS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## **Predispose**

To predispose is to increase a person's susceptibility or likelihood of developing a disease or response when additional triggers occur.

## **Prefixes, Medical**

Word beginnings that modify medical terms by indicating location, number, time, speed, size, direction, deficiency, excess, or other meaning, such as hyper-, hypo-, peri-, and brady-.

## **Pregnant**

Pregnant means carrying a developing embryo or fetus in the uterus after conception; pregnancy status affects medicines, imaging, and clinical decisions.

## **Premature Baby**

An infant born before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy, with risks related to immature lungs, brain, feeding, temperature control, immunity, and other organ systems.

## **Premenstrual**

Occurring during the days before menstruation; the term commonly refers to cyclical symptoms such as mood change, breast tenderness, bloating, headache, or fatigue.

## **Premie**

Premie is an informal term for a premature infant, born before 37 completed weeks of gestation and at risk for complications related to immature organs.

## **Prenatal**

Prenatal means occurring during pregnancy before birth, including care, testing, development, coun-

seling, and treatment of the pregnant person or fetus.

## **Prenatal Development**

Prenatal development is growth and differentiation of the embryo and fetus from conception to birth, influenced by genes, nutrition, maternal health, and exposures.

## **Preop**

Preop is an abbreviation for preoperative, meaning relating to preparation and assessment before surgery.

## **Prepubertal**

Prepubertal means before the physical and hormonal changes of puberty have begun or progressed to reproductive maturity.

## **Primary Immunodeficiency Disease**

A clinical condition involving primary Immunodeficiency Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## **Private Mutation**

A genetic variant confined to a family, individual, tumor, or small population rather than commonly seen in the general population; its significance requires genetic and clinical interpretation.

## **Probiotics**

Probiotics are live microorganisms that may provide a health benefit when consumed in adequate amounts, although effects are strain-specific and vary by condition.

## **PROC**

PROC is the gene symbol for protein C, an anticoagulant protein that limits clot formation; inherited deficiency increases thrombosis risk.

## **Process**

A process is an ordered series of biological, physical, chemical, or operational changes that produces a result.

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### **Proclivity**

Proclivity is a tendency or predisposition toward a particular behavior, response, disease, or outcome.

### **Proinflammatory**

Proinflammatory describes a substance, cell, or response that promotes inflammation through mediators such as cytokines, chemokines, or lipid signals.

### **Prophylactic**

Prophylactic means intended to prevent disease, infection, injury, or another unwanted outcome before it occurs.

### **Propylthiouracil (PTU)**

Propylthiouracil is an antithyroid drug that reduces thyroid-hormone synthesis and conversion of T4 to T3; liver injury and fetal risks require careful use.

### **Prostaglandin E2**

A prostaglandin that mediates inflammation, pain, fever, vasodilation, gastric protection, cervical ripening, and uterine contraction and is used in selected obstetric and cardiovascular treatments.

### **Prostaglandin F2-Alpha**

A prostaglandin that promotes smooth-muscle contraction and luteolysis; analogues are used in glaucoma, postpartum hemorrhage, labor-related care, and veterinary medicine.

### **Prostate Enlargement**

A biomedical term referring to prostate enlargement; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Prostatodynia**

Prostatodynia is an older term for pelvic or prostate-region pain without proven bacterial infection, now often considered within chronic pelvic pain syndrome.

### **Protean**

A biological or biochemical term involving protean.

Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Protein Malnutrition**

Protein malnutrition refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Proteolipid Protein**

Proteolipid protein refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Pruritic**

Itchy or causing an urge to scratch; pruritus can result from skin inflammation, allergy, infection, systemic disease, medications, or neuropathic mechanisms.

### **Pruritic Eruption**

An itchy skin eruption that may result from allergic, inflammatory, infectious, drug-related, or autoimmune disease; diagnosis depends on its morphology, distribution, timing, and associated findings.

### **Pseudomonas Aeruginosa**

*Pseudomonas aeruginosa* is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Pseudotumor Cerebri**

An older term for idiopathic intracranial hypertension, in which raised pressure around the brain causes headache, transient visual obscurations, pulsatile tinnitus, and possible papilledema without a mass lesion.

### **PSP**

PSP commonly means progressive supranuclear palsy, a neurodegenerative disorder causing early postural instability, vertical gaze impairment, rigidity, and cognitive change.

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## Psychiatric

Relating to the assessment, diagnosis, treatment, or prevention of disorders of mood, thought, perception, behavior, or emotional functioning.

## Psycho-Oncology

The clinical and research field addressing psychological, social, behavioral, and communication needs of people with cancer and their families across diagnosis, treatment, survivorship, and end of life.

## Psychologist, Clinical

A licensed mental-health professional who assesses and treats psychological, emotional, behavioral, and cognitive problems using psychotherapy and other evidence-based interventions within local scope of practice.

## Psychotropic Medication

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to psychotropic medication; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## PTC (Percutaneous Transhepatic Cholangiography)

PTC is imaging of the bile ducts after contrast is injected through a needle passed through the skin and liver; drainage or stenting may follow.

## PTU

PTU is the abbreviation for propylthiouracil, an antithyroid medicine used selectively because of liver toxicity and other safety considerations.

## Pulmonary Medicine

A biomedical term referring to pulmonary medicine; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Pump-Oxygenator

A clinical or therapeutic concept involving pump-oxygenator. Its features, uses, and clinical significance depend on the relevant medical context.

## Pustulosis

A skin disorder characterized by sterile or infectious pustules, which may be localized or widespread and associated with inflammation, fever, psoriasis, drug reactions, or infection.

## Putrid Throat

Putrid throat refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

## PUVA

PUVA combines a psoralen medicine with ultraviolet-A exposure to treat selected skin diseases; eye protection and cancer-risk precautions are required.

## PV

PV is a context-dependent abbreviation, including polycythemia vera, plasma volume, or peripheral vision; the full term should be specified.

## PVB

PVB is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean paravertebral block, a regional anesthetic technique, or another medical term.

## PVC

A PVC, or premature ventricular contraction, is an early heartbeat arising in a ventricle; occasional PVCs are common, while frequent or symptomatic beats need evaluation.

## PX

PX is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean prognosis, patient, prescription, or a genetic marker; clinical documentation should spell out the intended term.

## Pyarthrosis

Infection of a joint with pus in the joint space, usually bacterial septic arthritis, causing acute pain, swelling, restricted movement, fever, and risk of cartilage destruction.



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## Pyelo

Pyelo is an informal shortening usually referring to pyelonephritis, an infection of the kidney and renal pelvis that can cause fever and flank pain.

## Pyrimidine

A molecular biology or biochemical term involving pyrimidine. Its role depends on the relevant molecule, pathway, and cellular context.

## PYY

PYY, or peptide YY, is a gut hormone released after eating that reduces appetite and slows gastrointestinal motility.

## Peyer's Patches

Organized lymphoid tissue in the mucosa and submucosa of the ileum. These aggregates sample intestinal contents and contribute to immune surveillance of the gastrointestinal tract.

### Synonyms:

ileal lymphoid nodules

## Pulmonary Arteries

The paired arteries that carry deoxygenated blood from the right ventricle to the lungs for gas exchange.

### Synonyms:

pulmonary artery

## Pet Allergy

An allergic reaction to proteins in an animal's skin flakes, saliva, or urine, commonly causing rhinitis, conjunctivitis, or asthma.

## Popliteal Artery Aneurysm

An abnormal enlargement of the artery behind the knee that may cause limb ischemia, clotting, or embolization.

## Primary Progressive Aphasia

A neurodegenerative disorder causing gradual worsening of language abilities, including speaking, naming, comprehension, reading, or writing.

## Paraneoplastic Syndromes Of The Nervous System

Neurologic disorders caused by an immune response to cancer rather than by direct tumor invasion or metastasis.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Paraneoplastic Syndromes Paraneoplastic Neurological Disorder Paraneoplastic Neurological Syndrome

## Pinched Nerve

Compression or irritation of a nerve that can cause pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness along the nerve's distribution.

### Synonyms:

Compressed Nerve Nerve Compression

## Pink Eye (Conjunctivitis)

Inflammation or infection of the conjunctiva causing eye redness, discharge, irritation, itching, or tearing.

## Pubic Lice (Crabs)

Infestation of coarse body hair by lice, usually causing intense itching and requiring treatment and contact precautions.

### Synonyms:

Crabs

## Painful Intercourse (Dyspareunia)

Persistent or recurrent genital pain before, during, or after sexual intercourse, with physical, hormonal, emotional, or relationship-related causes.

## Premature Ventricular Contractions (PVCs)

Early extra heartbeats originating in the heart's ventricles, often felt as fluttering, skipped beats, or pounding and frequently benign.

### Synonyms:

Extrasystole PVCs Ventricular Premature Contraction VPCs

## Pre-Hepatic Jaundice (Haemolytic Jaundice)

Jaundice caused by excessive breakdown of red

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blood cells before bilirubin reaches the liver, producing increased unconjugated bilirubin.

**Synonyms:**

Haemolytic Jaundice

**Post-Hepatic Jaundice (Obstructive Jaundice)**

Jaundice caused by obstruction of bile flow after bilirubin has been processed by the liver, commonly from gallstones, strictures, or tumours.

**Synonyms:**

Obstructive Jaundice

**Premature Labour (Preterm Labour)**

Labour that begins before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy and may result in preterm birth.

**Synonyms:**

Preterm Labour

**Precipitate Labour**

Unusually rapid labour, often defined as delivery within three hours of the onset of regular contractions.

**Plane Warts (Verruca Plana)**

Small, smooth, relatively flat warts caused by HPV, often occurring in groups on the face, hands, or legs.

**Synonyms:**

Verruca Plana

**Plantar Warts (Verruca Plantaris)**

Warts on the soles of the feet caused by HPV. Pressure may push them inward and produce pain during walking.

**Synonyms:**

Verruca Plantaris

**Pilomatrix Carcinoma**

A rare malignant tumor showing matrical hair-follicle differentiation, usually presenting as a firm dermal or subcutaneous nodule on the head, neck, or upper extremity; it may recur or metastasize.

**Pleomorphic Dermal Sarcoma**

An uncommon high-grade cutaneous sarcoma, usu-

ally on chronically sun-damaged skin of older adults, composed of markedly pleomorphic cells and capable of local recurrence or metastasis.

**Postinflammatory Hyperpigmentation**

Darkening of skin after inflammation or injury, caused by increased melanin production or its deposition in the epidermis or dermis.

**Proliferating Trichilemmal Tumor**

A usually low-grade follicular tumor arising from a trichilemmal cyst, most often on the scalp; large or recurrent lesions may show locally aggressive or malignant behavior.

**Primary Cutaneous B-Cell Lymphoma**

A B-cell lymphoma presenting primarily in the skin without evidence of extracutaneous disease at diagnosis; clinical behavior and treatment depend on the specific subtype.

**Pseudoangiomatous Stromal Hyperplasia**

A benign breast stromal proliferation forming slit-like spaces within dense collagen that may mimic vascular channels. It can be incidental or present as a palpable or imaging-detected mass.

**Plasma Cell Mastitis**

A chronic benign inflammatory breast lesion with prominent plasma-cell infiltration, often involving ducts beneath the nipple and potentially causing a mass, nipple retraction, or discharge. It can clinically mimic carcinoma.

**Paris System For Reporting Urinary Cytology**

A standardized framework for urinary cytology that emphasizes detection of high-grade urothelial carcinoma and uses defined categories to improve diagnostic consistency and clinical communication.

**Pancreaticobiliary Cytology**

Cytologic evaluation of pancreatic and biliary lesions, usually from fine-needle aspiration, brushings, or bile-duct sampling. It is used to assess neopla-

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sia, inflammation, and obstructive lesions alongside imaging and histology.

### **Pancreatic Ductal Adenocarcinoma**

The most common exocrine pancreatic malignancy, arising from ductal epithelium and often presenting late with painless jaundice, weight loss, pain, or pancreatitis. Diagnosis and staging rely on imaging, tissue sampling when needed, and multidisciplinary assessment.

### **Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumor**

A neoplasm arising from pancreatic neuroendocrine cells that may secrete hormones or be nonfunctioning. Behavior ranges from indolent to aggressive and is assessed by differentiation, grade, proliferative index, and stage.

### **Paget Disease Of The Anus**

An intraepithelial adenocarcinoma of perianal skin or anal mucosa presenting as a persistent eczematous, itchy, or eroded lesion. Biopsy is required, and associated underlying or distant malignancy must be evaluated.

### **Amnion Nodosum**

Multiple small nodules of vernix or amniotic debris attached to the amnion, usually associated with reduced or absent fetal urine contribution to amniotic fluid and oligohydramnios.

### **Chorangioma**

A benign vascular tumor of the placenta, usually small and incidental but occasionally associated with fetal anemia, hydrops, growth restriction, or other complications when large.

### **Circumvallate Placenta**

An extrachorial placental configuration in which the chorionic plate is smaller than the basal plate, producing a raised circumferential edge; it may be associated with bleeding, abruption, or growth restriction.

### **Exaggerated Placental Site**

An exuberant but benign proliferation of implantation-site intermediate trophoblast in the uterus or placental bed; it can mimic gestational trophoblastic neoplasia and requires pathologic correlation.

### **Invasive Mole**

A hydatidiform mole that invades the uterine myometrium or vascular spaces; it is a form of gestational trophoblastic neoplasia and may persist or metastasize.

### **Placenta Accreta Spectrum**

Abnormal adherence or invasion of placental villi into the uterine wall, ranging from accreta to increta and percreta; it can cause severe postpartum hemorrhage and requires planned obstetric management.

### **Placental Mesenchymal Dysplasia**

A rare placental lesion with enlarged cystic stem villi and abnormal chorionic vessels that can mimic a partial mole and may be associated with fetal growth restriction or other fetal abnormalities.

### **Proliferative Fasciitis**

A benign, reactive fibroblastic proliferation resembling nodular fasciitis but containing distinctive ganglion-like cells; it usually grows quickly and resolves or stabilizes after local treatment.

### **Proliferative Myositis**

A benign reactive proliferation within skeletal muscle that may present as a rapidly enlarging mass and mimic sarcoma. Imaging and biopsy are used to establish the diagnosis.

### **Plexiform Fibrohistiocytic Tumor**

A rare low-grade malignant fibroblastic and histiocytic tumor, usually arising in the dermis or subcutis of the upper extremities of young people; local recurrence is common and metastasis is uncommon.

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### **Phosphaturic Mesenchymal Tumor**

A usually benign mesenchymal tumor that secretes fibroblast growth factor 23 and causes tumor-induced osteomalacia with phosphate wasting, bone pain, weakness, and fractures; removal is usually curative.

### **Pleomorphic Xanthoastrocytoma**

A circumscribed astrocytic tumor, often arising superficially in the cerebral hemispheres of younger patients and associated with seizures. Most are low grade, but anaplastic transformation can occur.

### **Pineal Parenchymal Tumor**

A tumor arising from pineal cells, ranging from pineocytoma to pineal parenchymal tumor of intermediate differentiation and pineoblastoma. Symptoms may result from hydrocephalus or compression of nearby visual and ocular-motor pathways.

### **Papillary Fibroelastoma**

A small benign cardiac valvular tumor composed of avascular frond-like elastic tissue. It may be incidental but can cause embolic events, particularly when mobile or located on the left-sided valves.

### **Paget Disease Of The Vulva**

An intraepithelial adenocarcinoma of vulvar skin, usually presenting as a persistent itchy, eczematous, or erythematous plaque. Biopsy and evaluation for an associated underlying or distant malignancy are required.

### **Pleomorphic Adenoma Of The Vulva**

An exceptionally rare benign mixed epithelial and mesenchymal tumor of the vulva, resembling pleomorphic adenoma of salivary tissue and requiring histopathologic confirmation.

### **Periosteal Osteosarcoma**

A surface osteosarcoma arising beneath the periosteum, usually producing cartilage and affecting the shaft of a long bone. It is generally intermediate grade and requires specialist orthopedic-oncology management.

### **Pediatric Ophthalmology**

The subspecialty caring for eye and vision disorders in infants, children, and adolescents, including strabismus, amblyopia, congenital abnormalities, refractive error, and childhood eye disease.

### **Piebaldism**

A rare congenital disorder of melanocyte development caused most often by pathogenic variants affecting the KIT signaling pathway. It produces stable, sharply demarcated depigmented patches of skin and a characteristic white forelock or localized poliosis from birth. The lesions usually remain non-progressive, although their distribution and degree of pigment loss vary among affected individuals. Diagnosis is generally clinical, with genetic assessment considered when features suggest a broader pigmentary or syndromic disorder.

### **Prosoplasia**

Development of a new or more specialized cellular function or phenotype within a tissue. The term describes progressive differentiation toward an advanced functional state rather than loss of differentiation or disordered maturation. It may be used in developmental biology and pathology to characterize cellular specialization in response to genetic, environmental, or tissue-specific signals. Interpretation depends on the tissue, developmental stage, molecular pathways, and whether the change is physiologic, adaptive, or associated with disease.

## Q

### Q Fever

A zoonotic disease caused by *Coxiella burnetii*, an obligate intracellular Gram-negative bacterium. Q fever is transmitted to humans primarily by inhalation of contaminated aerosols from infected livestock (cattle, sheep, goats) and their products (placenta, birth fluids, urine, feces, milk). Incubation: 2–3 weeks.

### Quantitative Computed Tomography

CT-based imaging that measures bone mineral density as well as showing bone structure.

### Q-T Interval

The ECG interval from the start of ventricular depolarization to the end of repolarization; it is corrected for heart rate when assessing arrhythmia risk.

### Quantitative Digital Radiography

Digital X-ray imaging that uses measured pixel data for assessment of anatomy, density, or change over time.

### Quadruplets

Four offspring born from the same pregnancy or four infants born in a multiple birth.

### Queckenstedt's Test

A historical test in which jugular-vein compression was used during lumbar puncture to assess cerebrospinal-fluid pressure transmission; it is rarely used today.

### Quinghaosu

Another name for artemisinin, an antimalarial compound derived from *Artemisia annua* and used in

combination therapies.

### Quinolones

A class of synthetic antibiotics that inhibit bacterial DNA gyrase or topoisomerase IV.

### Quintuplets

Five offspring born from the same pregnancy or five infants born in a multiple birth.

**Synonyms:**

QCT

### Quick Relievers

Fast-acting medicines that relax airway muscle and rapidly ease bronchoconstriction.

**Synonyms:**

Rescue medicines

### Quiet Sleep

Non-REM sleep, during which brain and body activity generally slow.

**Synonyms:**

Non-REM sleep

### Q Wave

The negative deflection that follows the P wave in some electrocardiographic leads, representing initial ventricular depolarization.

### QALY

Quality-adjusted life year, a measure combining the length of life with a value assigned to health-related quality of life during that time.

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## QRS Complex

The deflection representing ventricular depolarization, consisting of a Q wave (initial downward deflection), R wave (upward deflection), and S wave (downward deflection after R). Normal duration is 0.06-0.10 seconds (1.5-2.5 small boxes). Widened QRS ( $>0.12$  s) indicates bundle branch block, ventricular rhythm, or hyperkalemia.

## QT Interval

The time from the onset of the QRS complex to the end of the T wave, representing total ventricular depolarization and repolarization. Normal QT is 0.35-0.44 seconds. The corrected QT (QTc) adjusts for heart rate using Bazett's formula:  $QTc = QT / \text{square root of RR interval}$ .

## QT Prolongation

An electrocardiographic finding characterized by prolongation of the QT interval, representing the time from ventricular depolarization to repolarization, which predisposes to the potentially fatal arrhythmia torsades de pointes. The corrected QT interval should be less than 440 milliseconds in men and 460 milliseconds in women.

## Quad Screen (Maternal Serum Screening)

Second-trimester prenatal screening (15-22 weeks) for fetal aneuploidy and neural tube defects. Measures 4 markers: AFP (alpha-fetoprotein: elevated in NTD, low in Down syndrome), hCG (elevated in Down syndrome), uE3 (unconjugated estriol: low in Down syndrome), and inhibin A (elevated in Down syndrome).

### Synonyms:

Maternal Serum Screening

## Quadrant

One of four sections of the abdomen (RUQ, LUQ, RLQ, LLQ) used for clinical description. RUQ: liver, gallbladder, duodenum, right kidney. LUQ: stomach, spleen, left kidney, pancreas tail. RLQ: appendix, cecum, right ovary. LLQ: sigmoid colon, left ovary.

## Quadrantectomy

Surgical removal of one quadrant of an organ, most commonly a breast-conserving operation removing a breast tumour with a surrounding margin of tissue. The exact procedure and need for additional treatment depend on pathology and clinical staging.

## Quadriceps Femoris

The four-headed muscle group on the anterior thigh consisting of rectus femoris and the three vasti. It extends the knee; rectus femoris also flexes the hip, and the group contributes to standing, walking, and shock absorption.

## Quadriceps Femoris Muscle

Four-muscle anterior thigh group: rectus femoris, vastus lateralis, vastus medialis, vastus intermedius, all inserting on the tibial tuberosity via the patellar ligament. Innervated by femoral nerve (L2-L4). Primary knee extensor for walking, running, rising from seated. VMO is important for patellar tracking.

## Quadriceps Injury

Damage to the quadriceps muscle or tendon caused by sudden force, overuse, or direct trauma. It may cause front-of-thigh pain, bruising, weakness, or difficulty extending the knee. Severe pain, a palpable defect, or inability to bear weight requires assessment for a significant tear or tendon rupture.

## Quadriceps Tendon Ruptures

A tear of the tendon connecting the quadriceps muscle to the patella, causing weakness or inability to extend the knee. Complete tears often require surgical repair; treatment depends on the extent of injury and the person's functional needs.

## Quadriplegia

Paralysis of all four limbs and trunk, resulting from a spinal cord lesion at the cervical level or a bilateral brainstem lesion. Common causes include traumatic spinal cord injury, stroke, multiple sclerosis, spinal cord tumors, and demyelinating disease.

## Quadruplet Pregnancy

A pregnancy involving four fetuses. It carries in-



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creased risks of preterm birth, fetal growth restriction, hypertensive and metabolic complications, and maternal morbidity and therefore requires specialized multidisciplinary antenatal care.

### **Quality Assurance**

Planned activities used to verify that healthcare services meet defined standards of safety, quality, and performance.

### **Quality Control**

Daily, weekly, monthly tests ensure system performance. Uniformity, energy, sensitivity, spatial resolution, count rate performance.

### **Quality Control (Laboratory)**

Procedures using control materials, calibration, equipment checks, and documented review to ensure that a laboratory method remains accurate and precise during routine testing.

#### **Synonyms:**

Laboratory

### **Quality Improvement**

Systematic efforts to improve healthcare. Methods: PDSA cycles, Lean, Six Sigma. Outcomes: safety, effectiveness, patient-centeredness.

### **Quality Of Life**

A person's perceived physical, psychological, social, and functional well-being.

### **Quality-Adjusted Life Year**

A health-economic measure combining length of life with health-related quality of life on a scale where 1 represents full health and 0 represents death. It is used to compare cost-effectiveness across interventions.

### **Quantification**

Measurement of radiotracer uptake or clearance. SUV (PET), clearance rates (renal), ejection fraction (cardiac). Essential for treatment monitoring.

### **Quantitative PET**

The measurement or estimation of radiotracer concentration and tissue kinetics from PET data, using measures such as standardized uptake value or compartmental modeling.

### **Quarantine**

Separation or restriction of movement of people who have been exposed to an infectious disease while monitoring whether they become ill. It differs from isolation of people who are already infected.

### **Quickening**

The first perception of fetal movement by the mother, typically felt between 16-20 weeks in multiparous women and 18-22 weeks in nulliparous women. Described initially as a subtle fluttering sensation that becomes stronger and more regular as pregnancy progresses.

### **Quiescent**

Inactive or dormant state of disease. Example: quiescent ulcerative colitis (no symptoms but histologic inflammation may persist).

### **Quinine**

An alkaloid derived from cinchona bark, with antimalarial, antipyretic, and skeletal muscle relaxant properties. Quinine is a blood schizonticide with activity against all Plasmodium species, but resistance has emerged in *P. falciparum*.

### **Quinsy**

A peritonsillar abscess: a collection of pus between the tonsillar capsule and the superior pharyngeal constrictor muscle, usually developing as a complication of tonsillar infection.

### **Quinupristin-Dalfopristin**

A streptogramin antibiotic combination that inhibits bacterial protein synthesis. It is used intravenously for selected serious gram-positive infections, including some resistant *Enterococcus faecium* infections, when appropriate alternatives are unavailable.

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## Quorum Sensing

Cell-density-dependent bacterial communication system in which bacteria produce and detect small signaling molecules (autoinducers—acyl-homoserine lactones in gram-negative, autoinducing peptides in gram-positive, AI-2 inter-species) to coordinate population-wide behaviors.

## Quadripareisis

Weakness affecting all four limbs, usually resulting from cervical spinal-cord disease, brain injury, neuromuscular disease, or another disorder of the central or peripheral nervous system.

## Quinolone

A class of synthetic antibacterial drugs that inhibit bacterial DNA gyrase or topoisomerase IV. Examples include ciprofloxacin and levofloxacin.

## Quadrantanopia

Loss of vision in one quarter of the visual field, usually caused by a lesion affecting specific portions of the optic pathways.

## Quadriceps Tendon Rupture

A tear of the tendon connecting the quadriceps muscle to the patella, causing pain, swelling, and inability to actively extend the knee.

## Quadriceps Tendinitis

Overuse-related inflammation or degeneration of the quadriceps tendon, causing pain above the kneecap that worsens with jumping, running, or resisted knee extension.

## Quartan Fever

A fever pattern in which fever attacks recur approximately every 72 hours, classically associated with infection by *Plasmodium malariae*.

## Quincke's Disease (Angioneurotic Oedema)

Sudden swelling of deeper layers of the skin or mucosa, commonly affecting the lips, face, tongue, throat, or bowel; airway involvement is an emer-

gency.

### Synonyms:

Angioneurotic Oedema

## Quincke's Pulse

Visible capillary pulsation in the nail bed or skin, often associated with a wide pulse pressure and severe aortic regurgitation.

## Quincke's Sign

A sign of severe aortic regurgitation in which alternating flushing and blanching of the nail bed or skin can be seen with each heartbeat.

## Quotidian Fever

A fever pattern in which fever attacks occur approximately every 24 hours; it may occur in malaria and several other infections.

## Qigong

Qigong is a traditional mind–body practice combining controlled movement, breathing, and attention; it may support relaxation or function, but evidence and safety vary and it should not replace indicated medical care.

## Quality

In healthcare, quality is the degree to which care is safe, effective, timely, equitable, efficient, and centered on patient needs, measured against defined standards or outcomes.

## Quantum Dot

A quantum dot is a nanoscale semiconductor particle whose size-dependent electronic properties produce characteristic light emission; medical research uses include imaging probes, biosensors, and targeted delivery systems.

## Quassins

Bitter triterpenoid compounds found in *Quassia* species and responsible for much of the plant's bitter taste; they have been studied experimentally for insecticidal and biological effects but have no established routine therapeutic use.

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## Quercetin

A flavonoid polyphenol found in many fruits, vegetables, and teas; it is marketed in supplements and studied for antioxidant and anti-inflammatory effects, but clinical benefits vary and interactions with medicines are possible.

## Questionnaire

A questionnaire is a structured set of written or electronic questions used to collect information about symptoms, exposures, behaviors, function, quality of life, or patient-reported outcomes; validity depends on its design and population.

## Quetiapine Fumarate

The fumarate salt of quetiapine, an atypical antipsychotic used for schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and selected adjunctive treatment of major depressive disorder. Sedation, metabolic effects, orthostatic hypotension, and movement-related adverse effects require monitoring.

## Quinalphos

An organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause a cholinergic toxidrome with sweating, salivation, vomiting, muscle fasciculations, weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure and requires urgent toxicology care.

## Quinapril

Quinapril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension and heart failure; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

## Quinazoline

A bicyclic nitrogen-containing heterocyclic chemical scaffold used in medicinal chemistry. Quinazoline derivatives include compounds with kinase-inhibitory and other pharmacologic activities.

## Quinidine

A class IA antiarrhythmic medicine that blocks cardiac sodium channels and prolongs repolarization. It is used selectively because it can cause QT prolongation, torsades de pointes, thrombocytopenia,

and other adverse effects.

## Quinolinic Acid

Quinolinic acid is a neuroactive intermediate in the kynurenine pathway and an agonist at NMDA receptors; excessive accumulation may contribute to excitotoxic neuronal injury and occurs in some inflammatory or neurologic conditions.

## Quinone Metabolism

quinone metabolism is a biochemical reaction, pathway, or chemical process in which molecules are transformed; its rate and effects depend on substrates, enzymes, and cellular conditions.

## Quinones

Oxidized aromatic compounds involved in electron-transfer reactions and redox chemistry. Some quinones have biological or pharmacologic roles, while others can generate reactive oxygen species or cause toxicity.

## Quinuclidines

A group of bicyclic tertiary amines containing the quinuclidine ring system, found in some natural products and medicines. Their effects depend on the attached chemical groups and receptor targets.

## Quipazine

An experimental serotonergic compound used mainly in pharmacologic and neurobehavioral research. It is not an established routine clinical treatment.

## Quadruple Screen Test

The quadruple screen measures maternal blood markers to estimate risk of selected fetal chromosomal or neural-tube conditions; it is a screening test, not a diagnosis.

## Quantitative Bence-Jones Protein Test

A quantitative Bence-Jones protein test measures free monoclonal light chains in urine, supporting evaluation and monitoring of plasma-cell disorders such as multiple myeloma.

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### **Quantitative Immunoglobulins**

Quantitative immunoglobulin testing measures classes of antibodies in blood and helps evaluate immune deficiency, chronic inflammation, monoclonal gammopathy, or abnormal immune activation.

### **Quantitative Nephelometry Test**

Quantitative nephelometry estimates specific proteins by measuring light scattered by immune complexes, supporting assessment of immunoglobulins, complement, and other serum proteins.

### **Questions To Ask Your Child's Doctor About Cancer**

Questions about a child's cancer should clarify the diagnosis, stage, treatment options, expected benefits and risks, clinical trials, supportive care, and follow-up plan.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor About Getting Pregnant**

Questions before pregnancy should address chronic conditions, medications, vaccinations, genetic risks, nutrition, fertility timing, and health changes that improve pregnancy safety.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor About Going Home With Your Baby**

Questions before taking a newborn home should cover feeding, sleep safety, medicines, warning signs, follow-up, immunizations, and when to seek urgent care.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor About Hospital Care After Delivery**

Questions after delivery should clarify maternal recovery, bleeding, pain, wound care, mood symptoms, feeding, contraception, newborn care, and follow-up.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor About Staying Healthy During Pregnancy**

Pregnancy health questions should address nutrition, activity, prenatal testing, medications, infection prevention, warning signs, and management of existing medical conditions.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor After Knee Replacement**

Questions after knee replacement should clarify wound care, pain control, mobility restrictions, exercises, clot prevention, infection warning signs, and rehabilitation milestones.

### **Questions To Ask Your Doctor Before Knee Replacement**

Questions before knee replacement should address the diagnosis, alternatives, implant choice, surgical risks, preparation, expected recovery, rehabilitation, and long-term activity.

### **Questions To Ask Your Health Care Provider About Labor And Delivery**

Labor and delivery questions should clarify birth-plan preferences, pain relief, monitoring, induction, cesarean indications, newborn care, and urgent situations.

### **Questions To Ask Your Health Care Provider About Post Pregnancy Care**

Post-pregnancy care questions should cover bleeding, pain, blood pressure, incision or tear healing, mood, contraception, lactation, pelvic recovery, and routine follow-up.

### **Questions To Ask Your Surgeon About Spinal Surgery**

Questions before spinal surgery should clarify the pain generator, goals, alternatives, procedure, neurologic risks, recovery restrictions, rehabilitation, and expected outcomes.

### **Quit Smoking (Smoking And Quitting Smoking)**

Alternate index label for Smoking and Quitting Smoking.

### **Q Arm Of A Chromosome**

q arm of a chromosome is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

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### **Q.2H**

A prescription abbreviation meaning “every 2 hours.” Medication instructions should use clear wording because abbreviation misinterpretation can cause dosing errors.

### **Q.3H.**

A prescription abbreviation meaning “every 3 hours.” Medication instructions should use clear wording because abbreviation misinterpretation can cause dosing errors.

### **Q.H. (On Prescription)**

Q.H. means every hour on a prescription; explicit plain-language instructions are safer than ambiguous abbreviations.

### **Q.I.D. (On Prescription)**

Q.I.D. means four times daily on a prescription; the exact timing and maximum dose should be written clearly.

### **Q.S.**

A prescription abbreviation from the Latin “quantum sufficiat,” meaning “quantity sufficient” to make the required amount or concentration. The exact quantity must be specified by the formulation or prescription context.

### **Qd (On Prescription)**

QD is intended to mean once daily, but it can be misread; prescriptions should use “daily” instead.

### **Quadriceps**

The four muscles on the front of the thigh that extend the knee; the rectus femoris also assists hip flexion. The quadriceps tendon connects them to the patella and contributes to the extensor mechanism.

### **Quaque (On Prescription)**

Quaque is Latin for every or each and appears in historical prescription abbreviations; modern instructions should use plain language.

### **Quaque Die (On Prescription)**

Quaque die means every day or once daily; clear modern medication directions should spell this out.

### **Quasidominant**

Describing an inheritance pattern in which a recessive trait appears in successive generations because affected individuals reproduce with carriers or because of a high disease frequency. It can resemble dominant inheritance in a pedigree.

### **Quater In Die (On Prescription)**

Quater in die means four times a day; explicit timing is preferable to this Latin abbreviation.

### **Quiescence**

A temporary state of cellular or physiologic inactivity or reduced activity. Some cells, including certain stem cells and latent infectious agents, may remain quiescent and later become active.





## R

### Rabies

Rabies is a nearly always fatal viral encephalitis transmitted through saliva, usually by an animal bite, but prompt wound care and post-exposure prophylaxis can prevent disease. infected animals. After inoculation, the virus travels to the CNS via peripheral nerves. Symptoms include hydrophobia, aerophobia, and progressive neurological deterioration. Diagnosis is made by direct fluorescent antibody testing of brain tissue.

### Radial Tunnel Syndrome

Compression of the radial nerve near the elbow, causing arm pain, tingling, or weakness.

### Radiation

Energy transmitted as particles or electromagnetic waves, including X-rays and gamma rays.

### Radical Prostatectomy

Surgery that removes the entire prostate, usually with nearby seminal vesicles.

### Radioallergosorbent Test

A blood test used to detect allergen-specific IgE antibodies.

### RAD

Acronym whose medical meaning depends on context, commonly radiation absorbed dose or right axis deviation on an ECG.

### Radioactive Isotopes

Unstable forms of elements that emit radiation and are used in nuclear imaging, treatment, or research.

### Radioactivity

Spontaneous decay of unstable atomic nuclei with emission of particles or electromagnetic radiation.

### Radiographer

A trained professional who performs diagnostic imaging examinations or delivers radiotherapy, depending on specialty and jurisdiction.

### Radiography

Production of images using X-rays or other ionizing radiation.

### Radiology

The medical specialty using imaging to diagnose disease and guide procedures.

### Radionuclide

A radioactive isotope used as a tracer or therapeutic agent.

### Radio-Opaque

Blocking X-rays and appearing relatively white on a radiograph; radiopaque is the modern spelling.

### Radiotherapy

Treatment using ionizing radiation to destroy or control abnormal cells, especially cancer.

### Radium

A radioactive chemical element; radium exposure can cause radiation injury and cancer.

### RâLe

An older term for an abnormal crackling or bubbling

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respiratory sound, now generally described as a crackle.

### **Raloxifene**

A selective estrogen-receptor modulator used mainly to reduce fracture risk in selected postmenopausal people.

### **Randomised Controlled Trial**

A study in which participants are assigned by chance to interventions or controls and outcomes are compared.

### **Ranitidine**

An H<sub>2</sub>-receptor antagonist formerly used to reduce gastric acid; availability has been withdrawn or restricted in many countries because of impurity concerns.

### **Rape**

Nonconsensual sexual penetration or sexual violence; it is a serious crime and a medical, safeguarding, and trauma-care concern.

### **Raphe**

A seam-like line or ridge where structures join, such as the median raphe or raphe nuclei of the brainstem.

### **Rarefaction**

Reduction in density or pressure, as in the low-pressure phase of a sound wave.

### **Raynaud's Disease**

Primary episodic vasospasm of fingers or toes triggered by cold or stress, causing color changes and numbness.

### **Read Codes**

A clinical coding system historically used to represent diagnoses, findings, and procedures in electronic health records.

### **Recombinant DNA Technology**

Laboratory techniques that join DNA from different

sources to produce a desired genetic construct or product.

### **Reconstructive (Plastic) Surgery**

Surgery that restores form or function after congenital difference, injury, disease, or removal of tissue.

### **Recovered Memory Syndrome**

A controversial and nonstandard label for memories recalled after an alleged period of amnesia; recovered memories require careful, non-leading assessment.

### **Recovery Position**

A side-lying position used for an unconscious but normally breathing person to help keep the airway open and reduce aspiration risk.

### **Recrudescence**

Recurrence of symptoms or infection after apparent improvement, often from persistence of the original organism or disease process.

### **Recurrent Laryngeal Nerve**

A branch of the vagus nerve supplying most intrinsic muscles of the larynx; injury can cause hoarseness.

### **Red Blood Cell**

An erythrocyte, the oxygen-carrying blood cell containing hemoglobin.

### **Reduction**

Restoration of a displaced fracture or joint to better alignment, or decrease in amount, size, or activity.

### **Reduction Division**

Meiosis, a cell division that reduces chromosome number by half to form gametes.

### **Reflex Action**

An involuntary, rapid response to a stimulus mediated through a reflex arc.

### **Regimen**

A planned schedule of medicines, treatments, diet, or other healthcare measures.

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### **Regional Anaesthesia**

Loss of sensation in a larger body region produced by blocking nerves or a nerve plexus while consciousness is usually preserved.

### **Regional Ileitis**

Crohn disease affecting predominantly the terminal ileum.

### **Registrar**

A doctor in postgraduate specialist training or a medical records professional, depending on context and country.

### **Regulation Of Health Professions**

Legal and professional systems governing training, registration, scope, conduct, and accountability of healthcare workers.

### **Reiter's Syndrome**

An older name for reactive arthritis, an inflammatory arthritis occurring after certain infections.

### **Relate Marriage Guidance**

Counseling or relationship support provided by Relate or similar services; it is not a medical diagnosis.

### **Relaxation Therapy**

Techniques such as breathing, muscle relaxation, or imagery used to reduce stress, arousal, or symptom burden.

### **Remittent Fever**

Fever that varies during the day but does not return to normal temperature.

### **REM Sleep**

Rapid-eye-movement sleep, a stage associated with vivid dreaming, active brain activity, and skeletal-muscle atonia.

### **Renal Cell Carcinoma**

A malignant tumor arising from renal tubular epithelium, most commonly clear-cell carcinoma.

### **Renal Diseases**

Disorders affecting kidney tissue or function, including glomerular, tubular, vascular, infectious, obstructive, and neoplastic disease.

### **Renal Tubule**

The nephron segment that modifies filtrate by reabsorbing and secreting water and solutes.

### **Renin**

An enzyme released mainly by juxtaglomerular kidney cells that initiates the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system.

### **Rennin**

An older spelling that may refer to renin or to rennet enzyme; in humans, renin regulates blood pressure and fluid balance.

### **Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI)**

Pain or dysfunction associated with repeated movements or sustained posture, commonly affecting tendons, nerves, and muscles.

### **Repressed Memory Therapy**

A controversial approach aimed at recovering allegedly repressed memories; suggestive techniques can create false memories and require caution.

### **Reproductive System**

The organs and tissues responsible for producing gametes, reproductive hormones, conception, and in some bodies pregnancy and birth.

### **Research**

Systematic investigation designed to generate or test knowledge.

### **Research Fraud And Misconduct**

Fabrication, falsification, plagiarism, or other serious breaches of standards in planning, conducting, reporting, or reviewing research.

### **Resection**

Surgical removal of part or all of an organ, tissue,

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or lesion.

**Synonyms:**

Resection, Intestinal

**Resection, Intestinal**

Alternate index label; see *Resection* and *Small bowel resection*.

**Reserve Volume**

The additional amount of air that can be inhaled or exhaled beyond a normal tidal breath.

**Residual Volume**

The amount of air remaining in the lungs after maximal forced expiration.

**Resistin**

A signaling protein associated with adipose tissue and inflammation; its human clinical significance remains under study.

**Resolution**

The ability of an imaging system to distinguish separate structures, or the improvement or disappearance of a disease or symptom.

**Resonance**

Amplification or characteristic vibration produced when a system is driven at a suitable frequency; used in sound and MRI contexts.

**Resorcinol**

A phenolic compound used in selected topical dermatologic preparations; concentrated exposure can irritate or poison.

**Respiration**

The processes of breathing, gas exchange, and cellular energy production involving oxygen and carbon dioxide.

**Respiratory Arrest**

Cessation of effective breathing, requiring immediate assessment and resuscitation.

**Respiratory Distress Syndrome**

Severe respiratory failure with diffuse lung injury; in adults it is ARDS, while neonatal RDS is surfactant deficiency.

**Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)**

A respiratory virus that commonly causes bronchiolitis and pneumonia in infants and can cause significant disease in older adults.

**Respiratory System**

The airways, lungs, respiratory muscles, and related structures that move air and exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide.

**Restless Legs Syndrome**

An urge to move the legs with uncomfortable sensations, worse at rest and in the evening or night.

**Restriction Enzyme**

A bacterial enzyme that cuts DNA at specific nucleotide sequences and is used in molecular biology.

**Retardation**

An outdated or context-dependent term for slowing or delay; modern clinical language should specify the affected function and cause.

**Retching**

Repeated involuntary effort to vomit without necessarily producing stomach contents.

**Retention Of Urine**

Inability to empty the bladder completely or at all despite urine production.

**Reticulocytes**

Immature red blood cells recently released from bone marrow; their proportion helps assess red-cell production.

**Reticulo-Endothelial System**

An older term for the mononuclear phagocyte system, including macrophages in blood, tissues, liver, spleen, and lymph nodes.

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## Retina, Disorders Of

Diseases affecting the retina, including vascular, degenerative, inflammatory, infectious, inherited, and neoplastic conditions.

### Retina

The light-sensitive neural tissue lining the back of the eye that converts light into nerve signals.

### Retinoblastoma

A malignant retinal tumor occurring mainly in young children, associated with RB1 gene abnormalities.

#### Synonyms:

Cancer, Retinoblastoma

### Retinoic Acid

An active metabolite of vitamin A that regulates gene expression and cell differentiation; it is used in selected dermatologic and cancer treatments.

### Retinoids

Vitamin-A-related compounds used in selected dermatologic, ophthalmic, and oncologic treatments.

### Retinol

Vitamin A alcohol, important for vision, epithelial health, and immune function.

### Retinopathy

Disease or damage of the retina, often due to diabetes, hypertension, prematurity, vascular disease, or inherited disorders.

### Retractor

An instrument or muscle that pulls a structure backward or holds tissue aside during examination or surgery.

### Retro-

A combining form meaning backward, behind, or posterior.

### Retrobulbar Neuritis

Inflammation or demyelination of the optic nerve

behind the eyeball, causing painful visual loss and often associated with multiple sclerosis.

### Retrograde

Moving backward or against the normal direction, such as retrograde amnesia or retrograde blood flow.

### Retropharyngeal Abscess

A collection of pus behind the pharynx, potentially obstructing the airway or spreading into the chest.

### Retrospectoscope

A historical instrument or method for examining past events or records; the term is not a standard current clinical procedure.

### Retroversion

Backward tilting or turning of an organ, especially a uterus tilted toward the spine.

### Retrovirus

An RNA virus that uses reverse transcriptase to make DNA from its RNA genome, including HIV.

### Revalidation

Formal reassessment that a healthcare professional remains fit, competent, and up to date to practice.

### Reverse Transcriptase

An enzyme that synthesizes DNA using RNA as a template.

### Reverse Transcriptase Inhibitor

An antiviral medicine that blocks reverse transcriptase, used in combination treatment for HIV or selected infections.

### Reye's Syndrome

A rare, potentially fatal illness causing acute brain dysfunction and liver injury, associated particularly with viral illness and aspirin exposure in children.

### Rhabdoviruses

A family of bullet-shaped RNA viruses including rabies virus and vesicular stomatitis virus.

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### Rhesus Factor

The Rh blood-group antigen, especially the D antigen, whose presence or absence is important in transfusion and pregnancy.

### Rhesus System

The Rh blood-group system, a group of inherited red-cell antigens including D, C, c, E, and e. RhD status is commonly reported as positive or negative and is important in transfusion compatibility and prevention of hemolytic disease of the fetus and newborn.

### Rheumatic Fever

An inflammatory complication of untreated or inadequately treated group A streptococcal throat infection, affecting joints, heart, skin, or brain.

### Rheumatoid Arthritis

A chronic autoimmune inflammatory arthritis causing synovitis, pain, stiffness, deformity, and possible systemic disease.

#### Synonyms:

RA RA (Rheumatoid Arthritis)

### Rheumatology

The medical specialty concerned with inflammatory, autoimmune, and musculoskeletal disorders.

### Rh Factor

The Rh blood-group antigen system, especially the D antigen.

### Rhinitis

Inflammation of the nasal lining causing congestion, discharge, sneezing, or itching.

### Rhinophyma

Progressive thickening and enlargement of the nose, usually associated with advanced rosacea.

### Rhinoplasty

Surgery to reshape or reconstruct the nose for functional or cosmetic reasons.

### Rhinorrhoea

Discharge of watery or mucoid fluid from the nose.

### Rhinoviruses

A group of viruses that commonly cause the common cold and can worsen asthma.

### Rhizotomy

Surgical or radiofrequency interruption of selected nerve roots to reduce pain, spasticity, or abnormal reflexes.

### Rhonchi

Low-pitched continuous respiratory sounds caused by airflow through narrowed or mucus-filled large airways.

### Rhythm Method

A fertility-awareness method that estimates fertile days from menstrual-cycle timing to avoid or achieve pregnancy.

### Ribavirin

An antiviral medicine used in selected viral infections, usually in combination and under specialist supervision.

### Riboflavin

Vitamin B2, a precursor of FAD and FMN needed for cellular energy metabolism.

### Ribonucleic Acid

RNA, a nucleic acid involved in genetic information transfer, protein synthesis, regulation, and some catalytic functions.

### Ribosome

A cellular structure that translates messenger RNA into protein.

### Ribozyme

An RNA molecule with catalytic activity.



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## Ribs

The curved bones forming much of the chest wall and protecting the heart and lungs.

## Rickets

Defective mineralization of growing bone, usually due to vitamin D, calcium, or phosphate deficiency.

### Synonyms:

Osteomalacia (Rickets)

## Rickettsia

A group of small intracellular bacteria transmitted mainly by arthropods and causing diseases such as typhus and spotted fevers.

## Rifampicin

A rifamycin antibiotic used in tuberculosis and selected other bacterial infections, usually in combination to prevent resistance.

## Rift Valley Fever

A mosquito-borne viral disease affecting animals and humans, usually causing fever but sometimes severe eye, brain, or hemorrhagic disease.

## Rigidity

Abnormally increased resistance to passive movement, classically seen in Parkinson disease or meningeal irritation.

## Rigor

Marked stiffness or rigidity; rigor mortis is post-mortem muscle stiffening, while rigor may also mean a severe chill.

## Ring Block

Local anesthetic injected around the base of a finger or toe to numb the entire digit.

## Ringworm

A contagious superficial fungal infection of skin, hair, or nails; it is not caused by a worm.

### Synonyms:

Scalp And Body (Ringworm)

## Rinnes Test

Rinne's test compares air and bone conduction with a tuning fork to help assess conductive hearing loss.

## Risk Factor

A characteristic, exposure, or behavior associated with increased probability of disease or another outcome.

## Risk Management

Identification, assessment, reduction, and monitoring of hazards that could cause harm.

## Risk Register

A documented list of identified risks, their likelihood, impact, controls, owners, and review status.

## Risus Sardonicus

A fixed, sardonic facial spasm classically associated with tetanus or strychnine poisoning.

## Ritodrine

A beta-2 agonist formerly used as a tocolytic to delay premature labor; it has limited current use because of maternal adverse effects.

## Rivastigmine

A cholinesterase inhibitor used for mild-to-moderate Alzheimer disease and Parkinson disease dementia.

## RNA

Ribonucleic acid, a nucleic acid involved in gene expression and regulation.

## Robotic Surgery

Computer-assisted surgery using robotic instruments controlled by a surgeon.

## Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever

A potentially severe tick-borne infection caused by *Rickettsia rickettsii*.

## Rodent Ulcer

An older name for basal cell carcinoma, a common

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locally invasive skin cancer.

### **Rombergism**

Unsteadiness or falling when standing with feet together and eyes closed, indicating impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

### **Root Filling**

Dental treatment in which the cleaned root canal is sealed to prevent reinfection.

### **Rorschach Test**

A projective psychological test using inkblots; its diagnostic validity is limited and interpretation requires specialist training.

### **Rosacea**

A chronic inflammatory facial skin disorder causing flushing, persistent redness, visible vessels, papules, pustules, or ocular symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Acne Rosacea (Rosacea)

### **Roseola Infantum**

A common childhood viral illness, usually caused by human herpesvirus 6, with high fever followed by a trunk rash as fever resolves.

### **Rotator Cuff**

The group of four shoulder muscles and tendons that stabilize the glenohumeral joint and rotate the arm.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tendinitis Rotator Cuff (Rotator Cuff)

### **Rotaviruses**

Viruses that cause acute gastroenteritis, especially severe diarrhea and dehydration in young children.

### **Roughage**

Dietary fiber, particularly the indigestible part of plant foods that supports bowel function.

### **Rouleaux**

Stacking of red blood cells like coins, often caused

by increased plasma proteins.

### **Roundworms**

Nematode worms, some of which infect humans and cause intestinal or tissue disease.

### **Rous Sarcoma**

A malignant connective-tissue tumor caused by Rous sarcoma virus in chickens; the historical term is important in cancer biology rather than routine human diagnosis.

### **RSI**

Repetitive strain injury, a group of pain and dysfunction syndromes associated with repeated movement or sustained posture.

### **RSV**

Respiratory syncytial virus, a common respiratory virus that can cause bronchiolitis and pneumonia.

### **Rubella**

A contagious viral infection causing mild fever and rash but potentially severe congenital abnormalities when acquired during pregnancy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Measles, German Three-Day Measles

### **Ryle's Tube**

A nasogastric tube used to drain stomach contents or deliver fluids, nutrition, or medicines.

#### **Synonyms:**

RAST

### **Radiofrequency**

Electromagnetic energy used in some diagnostic and therapeutic medical procedures.

#### **Synonyms:**

RF energy

### **Radiograph**

An image produced using X-rays.

#### **Synonyms:**

X-ray

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### **Radionuclide Imaging Or Scan**

Imaging that detects radiation from a tracer administered to the patient.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nuclear scan; scintigraphy

### **Radionuclides**

Radioactive atoms used as tracers in nuclear medicine imaging or treatment.

### **Rapid Eye Movement Sleep**

A sleep stage marked by rapid eye movements, vivid dreaming, and high brain activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

REM sleep

### **RAST**

A blood test for allergen-specific IgE antibodies.

#### **Synonyms:**

Radioallergosorbent test

### **Raynaud's Syndrome**

Episodic narrowing of small blood vessels in fingers or toes triggered by cold or stress.

#### **Synonyms:**

Raynaud phenomenon

### **RCT**

Randomized controlled trial, a study comparing randomly assigned intervention and control groups.

#### **Synonyms:**

Randomized controlled trial

### **RDA**

Recommended dietary allowance, the daily nutrient intake sufficient for nearly all healthy people in a defined group.

#### **Synonyms:**

Recommended dietary allowance

### **Rebound Insomnia**

Return or worsening of insomnia after stopping a sleep medicine.

### **Receptors**

Cell proteins or structures that bind specific signaling molecules and trigger a response.

### **Recombinant Tissue Plasminogen Activator**

A laboratory-produced clot-dissolving medicine used in selected emergencies.

#### **Synonyms:**

Recombinant tPA

### **Recommended Dietary Allowance**

The average daily intake expected to meet the nutrient needs of nearly all healthy people in a defined group.

#### **Synonyms:**

RDA

### **Rejection**

An immune response in which the body attacks transplanted tissue or an organ.

#### **Synonyms:**

Transplant rejection

### **Relaxation Response**

Physiological changes produced by relaxation practices that counter the stress response.

### **REM**

Rapid eye movement, a sleep stage associated with vivid dreams and intense brain activity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Rapid eye movement sleep

### **REM Behavior Disorder**

A sleep disorder in which a person acts out dreams during REM sleep.

#### **Synonyms:**

REM sleep behavior disorder

### **REM Rebound**

Increased REM sleep after REM deprivation or withdrawal of a REM-suppressing medicine.

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## Renal

Renal means relating to the kidneys, which filter blood, regulate fluid and electrolytes, produce hormones, and excrete urine.

## Reperfusion

Restoration of blood flow to tissue after an interruption.

## Reperfusion Therapy

Treatment that restores circulation to tissue deprived of blood, such as clot-dissolving treatment or angioplasty.

## Resistance

The ability of a microorganism to withstand a medicine that previously inhibited or killed it.

### Synonyms:

Drug resistance

## Resistant Hypertension

High blood pressure that remains above goal despite appropriate treatment with multiple medicines.

### Synonyms:

Treatment-resistant hypertension

## Respirologist

Physician specializing in diseases of the respiratory system, including lung transplantation evaluation and management.

## Restenosis

Re-narrowing of a blood vessel after it has been opened by angioplasty or another procedure.

## Resting Energy Expenditure

The calories the body uses at rest to maintain essential functions.

### Synonyms:

Resting metabolic rate

## Resuscitation

Emergency measures used to restore breathing and circulation.

### Synonyms:

CPR; revival

## Retinoid

A vitamin-A-related compound used in some skin treatments and other medical applications.

## Retrieval

Process of organ or tissue recovery from a donor for transplantation; also called procurement.

## Retrospective Study

A study that examines past records or exposures to investigate disease causes or outcomes.

## Revascularization

Restoration of blood flow to an area through bypass surgery, angioplasty, or another procedure.

## Rheumatic Disease

A clinical condition involving rheumatic Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Rheumatism

Pain, stiffness, or discomfort in joints and surrounding soft tissues.

## Rheumatologist

A physician specializing in inflammatory and autoimmune diseases of joints and connective tissue.

## Rhytidectomy

Cosmetic surgery that removes excess facial skin and tightens supporting tissues.

### Synonyms:

Facelift

## Risky Drinking

Alcohol use that increases the likelihood of health, safety, or social consequences.

### Synonyms:

Hazardous drinking

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## **RLS**

Restless legs syndrome, an urge to move the legs with uncomfortable sensations, especially at night.

### **Synonyms:**

Restless legs syndrome

## **Root**

The part of a tooth below the gum line.

## **Root Canal**

The channel inside a tooth root containing the pulp and its nerves and blood vessels.

## **Rupture**

A tear or complete break in an organ, vessel, muscle, or other tissue.

## **Ruptured Disk**

A spinal disk whose outer layer has torn, allowing inner material to bulge outward.

### **Synonyms:**

Herniated disk; slipped disk

## **Rabies Vaccination**

Immunization used before or after exposure to reduce the risk of rabies. Post-exposure management also includes wound care and, when indicated, rabies immunoglobulin.

## **Radial Artery**

The smaller terminal branch of the brachial artery, arising at the cubital fossa, running laterally along the radius to the wrist (palpable at the anatomical snuffbox) and hand. Supplies the lateral forearm and the thumb side of the hand; forms the deep palmar arch.

## **Radial Artery Thrombosis**

Formation of a thrombus in the radial artery, often at the site of arterial catheterization or in the setting of a hypercoagulable state or vasculitis. May cause hand ischemia with pain, pallor, and decreased pulse. Treatment includes anticoagulation and surgical intervention for limb-threatening ischemia.

## **Radial Club Hand**

A congenital longitudinal deficiency of the radial ray, ranging from thumb hypoplasia to complete absence of the radius. The hand is radially deviated due to the absent radial support, with the carpus displaced proximally and radially.

## **Radial Nerve**

From posterior cord (C5-T1), the plexus's largest branch. In the arm runs in the radial groove with the profunda brachii artery, innervating triceps and anconeus. At the elbow divides into superficial (sensory to dorsal hand) and deep (posterior interosseous) branches. Deep branch innervates forearm/hand extensors.

## **Radiation Biology**

The study of how ionizing or nonionizing radiation affects cells, tissues, organisms, and populations.

## **Radiation Contamination**

Unwanted radioactive material on a person, surface, object, or body site. Contamination may be removable or fixed and requires containment, monitoring, decontamination, and documentation according to radiation-safety procedures.

## **Radiation Dose**

The amount of ionizing radiation absorbed or received by a person or tissue. Dose varies with the examination, equipment, protocol, and patient size; imaging should be justified and optimized to obtain the needed information with the lowest reasonable exposure.

## **Radiation Emergency**

An event involving actual or suspected harmful radiation exposure or contamination that requires urgent protective and medical measures.

## **Radiation Enteritis**

Inflammation and injury of the small or large intestine caused by therapeutic ionizing radiation. It may be acute with diarrhea, cramping, and nausea or delayed with strictures, malabsorption, bleeding, fistula, or obstruction.

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### **Radiation Fibrosis**

Permanent scarring and stiffening of tissue caused by radiation injury, which may develop months or years after treatment. It can affect the skin, lungs, bowel, or other organs and may cause pain, reduced function, or shortness of breath.

### **Radiation Monitoring**

Measurement of radiation levels or individual exposure using devices such as personal dosimeters and area monitors.

### **Radiation Necrosis**

Irreversible tissue injury caused by ionizing radiation, often developing months or years after treatment. In the brain it may produce edema, seizures, headache, or focal deficits and can resemble recurrent tumour on imaging.

### **Radiation Oncologist**

A physician who uses ionizing radiation and related treatments to manage cancer and selected other diseases.

### **Radiation Oncology**

A medical specialty that uses high-energy radiation (such as X-rays or gamma rays) to shrink tumors and destroy cancer cells.

### **Radiation Physics**

The study and application of physical principles governing radiation production, detection, imaging, therapy, and protection.

### **Radiation Pneumonitis**

An inflammatory lung injury occurring weeks to months after thoracic radiation. It may cause dry cough, fever, dyspnea, and hypoxemia within the irradiated field and can progress to radiation fibrosis.

### **Radiation Poisoning**

Illness caused by substantial exposure to ionizing radiation, potentially producing skin injury, bone-marrow suppression, gastrointestinal symptoms, or organ failure.

### **Radiation Pregnancy Screening**

Assessment of pregnancy status before procedures involving ionizing radiation or radioactive materials when pregnancy is possible. The decision to proceed requires clinical justification, risk optimization, and consideration of gestational age and fetal dose.

### **Radiation Protection**

The practice of keeping radiation exposure as low as reasonably achievable while obtaining the required diagnostic or therapeutic result. It relies on justification, optimization, time reduction, distance, shielding, and appropriate contamination control.

### **Radiation Recall**

An inflammatory reaction that occurs in previously irradiated skin or mucosa after administration of certain chemotherapeutic agents, particularly antimetabolites and anthracyclines. It manifests as erythema, desquamation, or mucositis in the previously irradiated field, mimicking acute radiation dermatitis.

### **Radiation Safety**

Principles: time, distance, shielding. ALARA (As Low As Reasonably Achievable). Radioactive materials handled in designated areas. Waste disposal per regulations. Pregnancy screening for women of childbearing age.

### **Radiation Sickness**

Acute radiation syndrome caused by high-dose whole-body or substantial partial-body exposure to ionizing radiation. It may produce nausea, vomiting, marrow failure, infection, bleeding, gastrointestinal injury, neurovascular collapse, and death depending on dose.

### **Radiation Therapy**

Use of ionizing radiation to kill cancer cells. Types: external beam, brachytherapy, stereotactic. Mechanisms: DNA damage, cell death. Side effects: fatigue, skin reactions, site-specific effects.

### **Radiation-Induced Angiosarcoma**

A rare, aggressive soft tissue sarcoma arising in



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previously irradiated tissue, typically with a long latency period. It carries a poor prognosis due to local recurrence and metastatic potential.

### **Radiation-Recall Dermatitis**

An inflammatory skin reaction that occurs in a previously irradiated area after exposure to a triggering substance, often months or years later. The area may become red, swollen, painful, or blistered and requires clinical evaluation.

### **Radiculitis**

Inflammation or irritation of a spinal nerve root, causing radiating pain, paresthesia, sensory loss, weakness, or reflex change in a dermatomal or myotomal distribution. Causes include infection, inflammatory disease, disc pathology, and compression.

### **Radiculopathy**

Dysfunction of a spinal nerve root, usually from disc herniation, narrowing, or inflammation. It may cause shooting pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or altered reflexes along the affected nerve pathway.

### **Radioactive Iodine**

Used for thyroid imaging and treatment. I-131 emits beta particles (therapy) and gamma rays (imaging). Half-life: 8 days. Used for hyperthyroidism (Graves, toxic nodules) and thyroid cancer ablation. I-123 for diagnostics (shorter half-life, pure gamma).

### **Radioactive Iodine Ablation**

Treatment of differentiated thyroid carcinoma using iodine-131 to destroy residual thyroid tissue after total thyroidectomy. Indications include intermediate and high-risk disease for remnant ablation and treatment of residual or recurrent disease. Patients must be hypothyroid or receive recombinant TSH to maximize iodine uptake.

### **Radiobiology**

Study of radiation effects on biological systems. DNA damage, cell death, repair mechanisms.

### **Radiocarpal Joint**

The wrist joint between the distal radius and articular disc proximally and the scaphoid, lunate, and triquetrum distally. It permits flexion, extension, radial deviation, ulnar deviation, and circumduction.

### **Radiochemical Purity**

The fraction of total radioactivity present in the intended chemical form of a radiopharmaceutical. Impurities may alter biodistribution, reduce target uptake, and increase radiation dose to nontarget tissues.

### **Radiochemistry**

Chemistry of radiopharmaceuticals. Labeling, purification, quality control.

### **Radiocontrast**

A substance administered during imaging to make selected tissues, vessels, or body spaces more visible.

### **Radioembolization**

Intra-arterial delivery of radioactive microspheres (yttrium-90) to liver tumors through the hepatic artery, used for hepatocellular carcinoma and liver metastases.

### **Radiofrequency Ablation**

A procedure that uses high-frequency electrical energy to heat and destroy selected tissue, often under imaging guidance.

### **Radioimmunoassay**

Sensitive immunoassay using radiolabeled antigens or antibodies. Competitive binding principle. Used for hormone measurement (thyroid, reproductive), tumor markers, drug levels. Largely replaced by non-radioactive methods (ELISA) but still used for some assays.

### **Radiologic Technologist**

A trained health professional who performs selected medical-imaging examinations and helps protect patients from unnecessary radiation exposure.

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## Radiologic-Pathologic Correlation

Integration of imaging findings with gross and microscopic pathology to explain lesion location, extent, tissue composition, and sampling adequacy. It is important for discordant biopsy and imaging results.

## Radiologist

A physician trained to interpret medical images and, in some specialties, perform image-guided procedures.

## Radiology Report

Document describing imaging findings and interpretation. Structure: indication, technique, findings, impression. Clear, concise language essential. Critical findings require immediate communication.

## Radiology-Patient Identification

Verification of the correct patient, examination, body site, indication, pregnancy status when relevant, allergies, renal function, and prior imaging before image acquisition or intervention. It is a core diagnostic and procedural safety step.

## Radiolucent

Describing a material that allows relatively greater passage of X-rays and therefore appears darker on a radiograph or CT image. Air is highly radiolucent; some stones, foreign bodies, and lesions may also be radiolucent.

## Radionuclide Therapy

Internal radiation therapy using radiopharmaceuticals. Examples: I-131 (thyroid), Lu-177 DOTATATE (neuroendocrine tumors), Lu-177 PSMA (prostate cancer), Ra-223 (bone metastases), Y-90 microspheres (liver cancer).

## Radionuclidic Purity

The fraction of radioactivity arising from the intended radionuclide rather than contaminating radionuclides. It is important because contaminants may change radiation type, energy, half-life, dosimetry, and patient risk.

## Radiopaque

Describing a material that attenuates X-rays strongly and therefore appears relatively white on a radiograph or CT image. Bone, metal, and some contrast agents are radiopaque.

## Radiopharmaceutical

Radioactive compound used for diagnostic or therapeutic purposes. Components: radionuclide + targeting molecule. Selectivity determines biodistribution and image quality.

## Radiopharmaceutical Extravasation

Inadvertent leakage of a radiopharmaceutical from the injection vessel into surrounding tissue. It can reduce diagnostic accuracy and, with therapeutic agents, cause local radiation injury; the event requires documentation and dose assessment.

## Radiopharmaceutical Labeling Kit

A prepared set of reagents used to attach a radionuclide, commonly technetium-99m, to a compound for diagnostic imaging.

## Radiopharmaceutical Quality Control

Testing performed to verify identity, radionuclidic purity, radiochemical purity, pH, sterility, endotoxin limits, and other release specifications before clinical administration. Requirements depend on the preparation and jurisdiction.

## Radiopharmacy

Preparation and dispensing of radiopharmaceuticals. Good manufacturing practice (GMP) required. Sterility, pyrogen testing, quality control.

## Radiosensitization

Increased susceptibility of cells or tissues to injury from ionizing radiation.

## Radiotracer

A compound containing a radioactive nuclide that follows a biologic pathway and permits in-vivo imaging or measurement. Its distribution reflects the target physiology, receptor, enzyme, transporter, or

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tissue process.

### **Radium-223**

Alpha emitter, half-life 11.4 days. Used for bone metastases from prostate cancer. Mimics calcium, targets bone turnover sites.

### **Radius**

Lateral forearm bone in the anatomical position. Proximal end: head, neck, radial tuberosity. Shaft. Distal end: styloid process, articular surfaces. The radial head articulates with the capitulum and ulnar notch, allowing pronation/supination.

### **Rampant Caries**

Widespread severe caries affecting multiple surfaces. Associated with sugary drinks, xerostomia, bulimia.

### **Ramsay Hunt Syndrome**

Reactivation of varicella-zoster virus in the geniculate ganglion causing ipsilateral facial paralysis, severe ear pain, and vesicular eruption in or around the ear or oral cavity. Hearing loss and vertigo may occur; prompt treatment is important.

### **Randomized Controlled Trial**

An experimental study in which participants are assigned by chance to different interventions or a control condition and followed for specified outcomes.

### **Range Of Motion**

ROM: joint movement capacity. Goniometer measurement. Restrictions from contracture, pain, swelling.

### **Ranson Criteria**

Clinical scoring system for acute pancreatitis severity incorporating eleven parameters at two time points. Admission parameters include age, white blood cell count, glucose, LDH, and AST. Forty-eight hour parameters include hematocrit drop, BUN increase, calcium, oxygen tension, base deficit, and fluid sequestration.

### **Ranula**

A mucocele (mucus extravasation cyst) of the sublingual salivary gland, presenting as a blue-translucent, fluctuant swelling in the floor of the mouth, typically lateral to the lingual frenulum. A ranula results from trauma or obstruction of a sublingual gland duct, causing mucus accumulation in the sublingual space.

### **Rapid Sequence Induction**

An intubation technique designed to minimize aspiration risk in patients with full stomach.

### **Rapid Strep Test**

A test performed on a throat swab to detect Group A Streptococcus. It provides a rapid result, but a negative result may require confirmatory testing depending on the patient's age, symptoms, and local guidance.

### **Rapid-Sequence Intubation**

A planned emergency airway technique using a sedative-hypnotic and a neuromuscular blocker in rapid succession to facilitate tracheal intubation while minimizing aspiration risk. Preparation includes preoxygenation, backup airway plans, hemodynamic assessment, and confirmation of tube position.

### **Rapidly Progressive Glomerulonephritis**

A syndrome of rapidly worsening kidney function accompanied by glomerular inflammation, often with crescent formation on biopsy. Causes include anti-glomerular-basement-membrane disease, immune-complex disease, and pauci-immune vasculitis. It requires urgent evaluation and treatment.

### **Rasburicase**

A recombinant urate-oxidase enzyme that converts uric acid to the more soluble allantoin. It is used in selected patients at risk of or experiencing tumorlysis-related hyperuricemia. It can cause serious hypersensitivity or hemolysis in people with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency and requires appropriate screening and monitoring.

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## Rash

A general term for any visible skin eruption, change in skin color, texture, or appearance.

### Synonyms:

Allergy Rash (Rash)

## Rashes

Rashes are visible changes in skin color, texture, or sensation caused by infection, allergy, inflammation, medicines, or other disease.

## Rat Bite Fever

A systemic bacterial infection caused by *Streptobacillus moniliformis* or *Spirillum minus*, transmitted through rat bites or contact with rat-contaminated food or water. It presents with relapsing fever, rash, polyarthritis, and lymphadenopathy. The characteristic rash is petechial or maculopapular on the extremities.

## Rat-Bite Fever

Systemic infection caused by *Streptobacillus moniliformis* or *Spirillum minus* after exposure to infected rodents. Fever, migratory arthralgia, vomiting, and a maculopapular or petechial rash may occur.

## Raynaud Phenomenon

Exaggerated vasospastic response of digital arteries to cold or stress, causing well-demarcated color changes (white-blue-red) in fingers or toes. Primary Raynaud: idiopathic, symmetric, no tissue damage, normal capillaries.

## Raynaud Syndrome

A vasospastic disorder causing episodic digital color changes (white -> blue -> red) triggered by cold or stress, due to exaggerated vasoconstriction of digital arteries. Primary Raynaud: benign, symmetric, in young women, no underlying disease.

## Raynaud's Phenomenon

Episodic constriction of small arteries in the fingers or toes, causing color changes, numbness, or pain after cold exposure or emotional stress.

### Synonyms:

Raynauds Phenomenon (Raynaud's Phenomenon)

Raynauds Syndrome (Raynaud's Phenomenon)

## Reactivation Tuberculosis

Reactivation of latent infection, typically years later. Characteristically affects apical and posterior upper lobe segments. Features include chronic cough, hemoptysis, night sweats, weight loss, and cavitation.

## Reactive Arthritis

An inflammatory arthritis that develops after certain genitourinary or gastrointestinal infections. It may involve the joints, eyes, skin, or urinary tract; not every person has all of these features.

### Synonyms:

Arthritis Reactive (Reactive Arthritis) Arthritis Re-  
iters (Reactive Arthritis)

## Reactive Attachment Disorder

A pattern of inhibited, emotionally withdrawn behavior toward adult caregivers. The child rarely or minimally seeks comfort when distressed and rarely or minimally responds to comfort when distressed. The child shows a pattern of persistently irritable and sad mood that is not limited to interactions with caregivers.

## Reactive Oxygen Species

Superoxide, hydrogen peroxide, hydroxyl radical. Normal metabolism byproducts.

## Reactive Perforating Collagenosis

A perforating dermatosis in which dermal collagen is extruded through the epidermis, presenting as discrete, dome-shaped papules with a central keratotic plug, most commonly on the extensor extremities.

## Receiver Operating Characteristic

ROC curve: plot of sensitivity vs. 1-specificity. Area under curve measures test accuracy.

## Receptor

A protein that binds a specific signaling molecule (ligand) and initiates a cellular response. Types:

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(1) Cell surface: ion channel (nicotinic AChR), G-protein coupled (GPCR: adrenergic, muscarinic, opioid), enzyme-linked (RTK: insulin receptor, cytokine receptors).

### Receptor Desensitization

A rapid decrease in the response of a receptor to continuous or repeated agonist stimulation, occurring within minutes to hours.

### Receptor Downregulation

A decrease in the number or sensitivity of receptors in response to chronic receptor stimulation by agonists. When receptors are chronically activated, the cells compensate by internalizing and degrading receptors, reducing receptor density on the cell surface, and decreasing receptor responsiveness.

### Receptor Tyrosine Kinases

Single-pass transmembrane receptors with intrinsic tyrosine kinase activity in their intracellular domain. Ligand binding (e.g., insulin, EGF, PDGF, FGF) induces receptor dimerization and autophosphorylation of tyrosine residues.

### Receptor Upregulation

An increase in the number or sensitivity of receptors in response to chronic receptor blockade or decreased neurotransmitter activity. When receptors are chronically blocked by antagonists, the cells compensate by synthesizing more receptors to maintain homeostatic signaling, leading to increased sensitivity to agonists.

### Recessive

Allele whose phenotype is masked in heterozygotes. Autosomal recessive disorders: cystic fibrosis, sickle cell anemia, Tay-Sachs disease. Requires two copies for expression.

### RECIST

Response Evaluation Criteria in Solid Tumors, standardized imaging-based criteria that categorize response to anticancer therapy as complete response, partial response, stable disease, or progressive disease.

### Recombinant DNA

DNA molecule formed by combining genetic material from different sources. Basis of biotechnology. Used to produce insulin, growth hormone, vaccines, gene therapy vectors.

### Rectal Bleeding

Passage of bright-red or dark blood from the rectum, caused by hemorrhoids, fissures, polyps, inflammatory bowel disease, diverticular disease, or cancer. Persistent, heavy, or unexplained bleeding requires evaluation.

#### Synonyms:

Blood In The Stool (Rectal Bleeding)

### Rectal Prolapse

Protrusion of rectal tissue through the anal opening. Complete prolapse involves all layers of the rectal wall and presents as a concentric cylindrical mass with visible mucosal folds. Partial prolapse involves only the mucosa. Associated with chronic straining, pelvic floor dysfunction, and neurological conditions.

### Rectocele

A weakening of the vaginal wall that allows the rectum to bulge into the vagina.

### Rectovaginal Fistula

Abnormal connection between the rectum and vagina causing passage of stool or gas through the vagina. Causes include obstetric injury particularly third and fourth degree perineal tears, Crohn disease, radiation therapy, and surgical complications. Presents with vaginal discharge of stool, flatus, or recurrent vaginal infections.

### Rectum

The final straight section of the large intestine, approximately 12-15 cm long, extending from the sigmoid colon to the anal canal. The rectum stores feces before defecation.

### Rectus Abdominis Muscle

Long flat vertical anterior abdominal wall muscle



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from pubic symphysis to xiphoid process/costal cartilages 5-7, divided by tendinous intersections ("six-pack"). Innervated by T7-T12. Flexes trunk, compresses abdomen, increases intra-abdominal pressure. Diastasis recti common in pregnancy/obesity.

### **Rectus Abdominis Sheath**

A fibrous aponeurotic envelope formed by the abdominal wall muscles and surrounding the rectus abdominis muscle. It contains the superior and inferior epigastric vessels and related nerves.

### **Recurrence**

Return of cancer after treatment. Can be local, regional, or distant.

### **Recurrence Risk**

The probability that a genetic condition will occur again in a future pregnancy or relative, estimated from the inheritance pattern, parental testing, penetrance, and observed or presumed pathogenic variant.

### **Recurrence-Free Survival**

Time without cancer return after treatment.

### **Recurrent**

Disease returning after remission. Examples: recurrent UTI, herpes.

### **Recurrent Caries**

Caries under or around restoration. Due to microleakage, marginal breakdown.

### **Red Blood Cell Labeling**

Nuclear medicine technique labeling RBCs with Tc-99m. Used for GI bleeding detection, cardiac blood pool imaging.

### **Red Flag**

A symptom, sign, or test result suggesting a potentially serious condition that requires urgent assessment or escalation of care. Red flags are context-specific and should not be used as a substitute for clinical judgment.

### **Red Infarction**

Red infarction, also known as hemorrhagic infarction, occurs in tissues with dual blood supply, loose tissue architecture, or venous obstruction, allowing blood to accumulate in the necrotic area and produce a dark red appearance.

#### **Synonyms:**

hemorrhagic infarction, occurs in tissues with dual blood.

### **Redundant Mitral Valve**

Excess leaflet tissue of the mitral valve, most commonly the posterior leaflet, which may prolapse into the left atrium during systole. Often associated with myxomatous degeneration and mitral valve prolapse. May be asymptomatic or cause mild mitral regurgitation detected incidentally on echocardiography.

### **Reemerging Disease**

Previously controlled disease increasing. Examples: tuberculosis, measles, drug-resistant infections.

### **Reexpansion Pulmonary Edema**

Noncardiogenic pulmonary edema developing rapidly after rapid reexpansion of a collapsed lung, typically following chest tube drainage of a large or long-standing pneumothorax.

### **Refeeding Syndrome**

Life-threatening fluid and electrolyte shifts when nutrition restarted in malnourished patient. Hypophosphatemia, hypokalemia, hypomagnesemia, fluid overload, cardiac failure. Prevention: start low (25-30 kcal/kg), advance slowly, supplement electrolytes, monitor closely.

### **Reference Interval**

The range of laboratory results expected in a defined reference population, usually encompassing the central 95 percent of values. A result outside the interval is not by itself diagnostic and must be interpreted with clinical context, biologic variation, and the laboratory's method-specific range.



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## Referred Pain

An unpleasant sensory and emotional experience associated with actual or potential tissue damage, serving as a protective alerting system but becoming maladaptive when chronic (lasting >3 months). See pain.

## Reflex Anoxic Seizure

A brief seizure-like episode caused by transient cerebral hypoperfusion after a sudden painful or emotional stimulus, usually with pallor, bradycardia, and rapid recovery.

## Reflex Arc

The neural pathway that mediates a reflex action, bypassing conscious brain processing for rapid, automatic responses. A reflex arc consists of five components: (1) Receptor—sensory nerve ending detecting a stimulus (e.g., pain, stretch).

## Reflux

Gastroesophageal reflux in infants: effortless regurgitation of gastric contents, very common (physiologic 'spitting up') and usually benign, resolving by 12 months with maturation of the lower esophageal sphincter.

## Reflux Nephropathy

Renal scarring and chronic kidney damage caused by vesicoureteral reflux, recurrent urinary infection, or both. It may lead to hypertension, proteinuria, impaired growth, and chronic kidney disease.

## Refraction

Refraction examines refraction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. humour, crystalline lens, vitreous humour) to focus a sharp image on the retina. The refractive power of the eye is measured in dioptres (D). Emmetropia: normal refractive state—parallel light rays focus exactly on the retina without accommodation.

## Refractive Errors And Astigmatism

Refractive errors are vision disorders caused by the eye's inability to properly focus light onto the retina,

resulting in blurred vision.

## Refractive Surgery

Surgical procedures that reshape the cornea or alter the eye to correct refractive errors and reduce dependence on eyeglasses or contact lenses. Laser techniques include LASIK (corneal flap with excimer ablation), photorefractive keratectomy (surface ablation), and small-incision lenticule extraction (SMILE).

## Refractory

Resistant to a treatment or not responding adequately to it. The term may refer to cancer or other diseases.

## Refractory Period

The period after an action potential during which a cell cannot (absolute refractory period) or can only partially (relative refractory period) generate a new action potential.

## Refsum Disease

An autosomal-recessive peroxisomal disorder of phytanic-acid metabolism. It causes retinitis pigmentosa, anosmia, peripheral neuropathy, ataxia, hearing loss, ichthyosis, and shortened metacarpals or metatarsals with variable onset.

## Regadenoson Pharmacological Stress

Selective A2A adenosine receptor agonist used as a pharmacological vasodilator for nuclear myocardial perfusion imaging. Single IV bolus injection produces coronary vasodilation with fewer side effects than adenosine (less bronchospasm, AV block). Contraindicated in severe asthma or COPD requiring oxygen.

## Regional Anesthesia

Regional anesthesia involves the administration of local anesthetic agents to specific nerves or nerve plexuses to provide surgical anesthesia and postoperative analgesia for a defined body region.

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## Regulatory Approval

Authorization by a competent regulatory authority for a medicine, device, or procedure to be marketed or used for specified purposes after review of evidence.

## Regulatory T Cells

Tregs (CD4+ CD25+ FOXP3+): essential for peripheral tolerance. Thymic (tTreg) vs peripheral (pTreg) origin. FOXP3: master transcription factor; mutations cause IPEX.

## Regurgitation

The backward flow of blood through a heart valve that fails to close properly (valvular incompetence or insufficiency).

## Rehabilitation

A coordinated process that helps a person restore or adapt physical, cognitive, psychological, and social function after illness, injury, surgery, or disability.

## Rehabilitation Clinic

Outpatient rehabilitation facility.

## Rehabilitation Engineering

Technology development for disability: prosthetics, orthotics, assistive devices, environmental control.

## Rehabilitation Hospital

Inpatient facility specializing in rehabilitation.

## Rehabilitation Medicine

Physician specialty focusing on function, quality of life for patients with impairment, disability. Also called physiatry.

### Synonyms:

physiatry.

## Rehabilitation Motivation

Patient factors that influence participation in rehabilitation, including intrinsic and extrinsic motivation and engagement with therapeutic goals.

## Rehabilitation Potential

The expected capacity to improve function, independence, participation, or quality of life through rehabilitation. It depends on diagnosis, prognosis, cognition, motivation, comorbidity, social support, and environmental resources.

## Rehabilitation Unit

Hospital ward dedicated to rehabilitation.

## Reinfection

A new episode of infection by the same or a related pathogen after the original infection has resolved. Reinfection is distinct from relapse, in which the original infection persists or returns from an incompletely eradicated focus.

## Relapse

Return or worsening of a disease after a period of improvement or remission. The term is used for cancer and many noncancerous disorders.

## Relapse-Free Survival

The time from completion of treatment to recurrence of the cancer or death from any cause.

## Relapsing Fever

An acute febrile illness caused by *Borrelia* species, characterized by recurrent episodes of fever separated by afebrile intervals.

## Relapsing Polychondritis

A systemic autoimmune disorder causing inflammation and destruction of cartilage throughout the body. Airway involvement can cause tracheal and bronchial stenosis. Other features include auricular chondritis, nasal chondritis, ocular inflammation, and arthritis. Treatment is corticosteroids and immunosuppressants.

## Relative Afferent Pupillary Defect

An asymmetric reduction in the direct pupillary light response caused by unequal afferent input from the retina or optic nerve. It is detected with the swinging-flashlight test and is also called a Marcus

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Gunn pupil.

**Synonyms:**

a Marcus Gunn pupil.

**Relative Biological Effectiveness**

Ratio of dose of reference radiation to dose of test radiation for same effect. Alpha particles: RBE 10-20.

**Relative Risk**

Ratio of disease risk in exposed vs. unexposed.  $RR = (a/(a+b)) / (c/(c+d))$ .  $RR > 1$ : increased risk.  $RR < 1$ : protective.

**Reliability**

Consistency of measurement. Test-retest, inter-rater reliability.

**REM Sleep Behavior Disorder**

A sleep disorder in which the normal muscle paralysis of REM sleep is reduced or absent, allowing a person to move or vocalize while dreaming.

**Synonyms:**

Rapid Eye Movement Sleep Behavior Disorder

**Remifentanyl**

An ultra-short-acting synthetic opioid analgesic metabolized by non-specific plasma and tissue esterases, producing context-sensitive half-time of approximately 3 to 10 minutes regardless of infusion duration. This makes it ideal for total intravenous anesthesia (TIVA) combined with propofol, and for procedures requiring rapid emergence.

**Remission**

Decrease or disappearance of cancer signs. Complete remission: no detectable disease. Partial remission: significant reduction but not complete.

**Remitting Seronegative Symmetrical Synovitis With Pitting Edema**

RS3PE: an acute-onset, symmetric polyarthritis (usually in elderly) with pitting edema of the hands/feet, negative rheumatoid factor and anti-CCP, and marked response to low-dose corticosteroids.

teroids.

**Remodeling**

Bone adaptation to implant stress. Wolff's law: bone remodels along lines of stress.

**Renal Abscess**

A localized collection of pus within or around the kidney, usually caused by infection. Diagnosis and treatment may require imaging, antibiotics, and drainage.

**Renal Agenesis**

Congenital absence of one (unilateral, 1 in 1,000) or both (bilateral, 1 in 4,000) kidneys. Unilateral renal agenesis: usually asymptomatic, discovered incidentally — the solitary kidney undergoes compensatory hypertrophy. The contralateral kidney may have VUR, UPJ obstruction, or ectopia.

**Renal Anemia**

Anemia associated with chronic kidney disease, caused by reduced erythropoietin production and other factors such as iron deficiency, inflammation, and shortened red-cell survival. Evaluation and treatment are individualized; iron replacement and erythropoiesis-stimulating therapy may be considered when appropriate.

**Renal Artery**

A paired branch of the abdominal aorta supplying a kidney. It divides into segmental, interlobar, arcuate, and interlobular arteries within the renal parenchyma.

**Renal Artery Aneurysm**

A focal enlargement of a renal artery, often asymptomatic but capable of causing hypertension, thromboembolism, or rupture. Management depends on size, symptoms, anatomy, pregnancy, and growth, and may involve surveillance, endovascular treatment, or surgery.

**Renal Artery Doppler**

Ultrasound assessing renal artery stenosis. Screen-

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ing for renovascular hypertension.

### Renal Artery Embolism

Acute occlusion of renal artery from cardiac emboli typically from atrial fibrillation or mural thrombus. Presents with acute flank pain and hematuria. CT angiography shows filling defect. Treat with anticoagulation and possibly thrombolysis or embolectomy if caught early.

### Renal Artery Stenosis

Narrowing of renal artery causing renovascular hypertension. Atherosclerotic most common in elderly at ostium. Fibromuscular dysplasia in young women causing mid-distal stenosis with string-of-beads appearance. Flash pulmonary edema and declining function on ACE inhibitors indicate intervention.

#### Synonyms:

Renal Artery Disease Renal Vascular Disease

### Renal Biopsy

Percutaneous needle biopsy for histological diagnosis. Indicated for unexplained AKI, nephrotic syndrome, hematuria with renal involvement, and transplant dysfunction. Ultrasound-guided for accuracy. Complications include bleeding, arteriovenous fistula, and rarely loss of kidney.

### Renal Calculi (Kidney Stones)

Crystalline mineral deposits that form in the kidneys or urinary tract. They may cause severe colicky pain, blood in the urine, urinary obstruction, or infection.

#### Synonyms:

Kidney Stones

### Renal Changes In Pregnancy

Pregnancy increases renal blood flow and glomerular filtration. These changes lower usual serum creatinine values and may increase urinary loss of glucose and amino acids.

### Renal Clearance

The volume of plasma completely cleared of a substance by the kidneys per unit time, measured in mL/min. Clearance of any substance X is calcu-

lated as:  $CX = (U_x \times V)/P_x$ , where  $U_x$  is urine concentration,  $V$  is urine flow rate, and  $P_x$  is plasma concentration.

### Renal Colic

Severe, paroxysmal flank pain caused by ureteral obstruction, typically by a kidney stone, with radiation to the groin; often the worst pain experienced.

### Renal Cortex

Outer kidney portion between capsule and medulla. Granular tissue with glomeruli, convoluted tubules, and cortical collecting ducts. Extends between pyramids as renal columns. Receives approximately 90 percent of renal blood flow; primary filtration site.

### Renal Cryptococcosis

Infection of the kidney by *Cryptococcus* species, usually as part of disseminated cryptococcosis in an immunocompromised person.

### Renal Diet

Restricted protein, sodium, potassium, phosphorus for kidney disease. Individualized based on stage. Dialysis increases protein requirement.

### Renal Dose Adjustment

Modification of a medication dose, dosing interval, or both to account for reduced kidney clearance. The adjustment should use an appropriate estimate of renal function, drug-specific pharmacokinetics, treatment indication, and therapeutic monitoring when available.

### Renal Drug Excretion

The elimination of drugs by the kidney through glomerular filtration, active tubular secretion, and passive tubular reabsorption. Drugs eliminated renally (e.g., aminoglycosides, vancomycin, lithium, metformin) require dose adjustment in renal impairment.

### Renal Failure

Decline in kidney function leading to accumulation of waste products (azotemia) and electrolyte

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abnormalities. Acute kidney injury (AKI): rapid decline over hours to days, potentially reversible. Chronic kidney disease (CKD): progressive decline over months to years.

### **Renal Infarction**

Renal infarction results from occlusion of the renal artery or its branches, causing coagulative necrosis of the renal parenchyma. The kidney has end-arterial supply with limited collateral circulation, making it susceptible to ischemic injury even from small vessel occlusion.

### **Renal Leukemia Infiltration**

Kidney involvement by chronic lymphocytic leukemia or other hematological malignancies causing bilateral renomegaly and renal dysfunction. Leukemic cells infiltrate the interstitium and peritubular capillaries. May cause AKI from compression of tubules and vessels or chronic kidney disease.

### **Renal Mass**

Abnormality in kidney detected on imaging. Solid masses may be renal cell carcinoma. Cystic masses classified by Bosniak system.

### **Renal Medulla**

The inner part of the kidney containing the renal pyramids, loops of Henle, vasa recta, and collecting ducts. Its structure and blood supply help establish the concentration gradient used to concentrate urine.

### **Renal Osteodystrophy**

Bone disease in CKD including osteitis fibrosa, osteomalacia, adynamic bone disease, and osteoporosis. Results from calcium-phosphate imbalance, secondary hyperparathyroidism, and vitamin D deficiency. Manage with phosphate binders, vitamin D analogues, and parathyroidectomy for refractory hyperparathyroidism.

### **Renal Pelvis**

The funnel-shaped expansion of the ureter within the kidney, formed by the union of major calyces. It collects urine from the renal papillae and directs

it into the ureter.

### **Renal Replacement Therapy**

Treatment that substitutes for inadequate kidney excretory and regulatory function. Modalities include intermittent hemodialysis, continuous kidney replacement therapy, peritoneal dialysis, and kidney transplantation.

### **Renal Replacement Therapy Indications**

Urgent indications for dialysis include refractory hyperkalemia, severe metabolic acidosis, toxin exposure by a dialyzable agent, refractory fluid overload or pulmonary edema, and symptomatic uremia. The decision incorporates the patient's trajectory and overall goals of care.

### **Renal Scan**

Nuclear medicine imaging using Tc-99m compounds. Evaluates renal function, obstruction, blood flow. MAG3 for function, DTPA for GFR.

### **Renal Scintigraphy**

Renal imaging using Tc-99m compounds. MAG3 (tubular secretion) for functional assessment, DTPA (glomerular filtration) for GFR measurement. Used for obstruction, function, transplant monitoring, renin-mediated hypertension.

### **Renal Transplant (Renal Transplantation)**

Surgical placement of a functioning donor kidney into a person with advanced kidney failure. It can restore kidney function but requires suitability assessment and long-term immunosuppression.

#### **Synonyms:**

Renal Transplantation

### **Renal Trauma**

Kidney injury from trauma. CT staging guides management. Grades I-V based on injury severity.

### **Renal Tubular Acidosis**

Group of disorders with normal anion gap metabolic acidosis from impaired renal acid excretion or bicar-

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bonate reabsorption. Type 1 distal with impaired H<sup>+</sup> secretion and urine pH greater than 5.5. Type 2 proximal with impaired bicarbonate reabsorption. Type 4 hyperkalemic from aldosterone deficiency or resistance.

### Renal Ultrasound

Noninvasive imaging used to assess kidney size, structure, blood flow, and urinary obstruction. It is particularly useful when obstruction, cystic disease, or structural abnormality is suspected and is often used in the evaluation of acute or chronic kidney disease.

### Renal Vein

A paired vein draining each kidney into the inferior vena cava. The left renal vein is longer and crosses anterior to the aorta, receiving the left gonadal and suprarenal veins.

### Renin Inhibitor

A class of antihypertensive drugs that directly inhibit renin, the first and rate-limiting enzyme in the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system. Renin catalyzes the conversion of angiotensinogen to angiotensin I, which is then converted to angiotensin II by ACE. Aliskiren is the only direct renin inhibitor available.

### Renin-Angiotensin-Aldosterone System

A hormonal system in which renin initiates formation of angiotensin II, promoting vasoconstriction and aldosterone secretion. Aldosterone increases distal sodium reabsorption and potassium and hydrogen-ion secretion; RAAS dysregulation contributes to hypertension, heart failure, and CKD progression.

### Renin-Angiotensin-Aldosterone System Physiology

The RAAS regulates blood pressure and fluid electrolyte balance. Renin released from juxtaglomerular cells cleaves angiotensinogen to angiotensin I. Angiotensin converting enzyme converts angiotensin I to angiotensin II which causes vasoconstriction and stimulates aldosterone secretion from the adrenal

cortex.

### Renography

Nuclear medicine imaging of kidneys. Evaluates function, obstruction, blood flow.

### Renovascular Hypertension

Hypertension due to renal artery stenosis. Diagnosis: Doppler ultrasound, CTA, MRA, renography. Treatment: angioplasty, stenting, surgery.

### Reperfusion Injury

Tissue damage following restoration of blood flow after ischemia. Mechanisms: oxidative stress, calcium overload, inflammation. Examples: myocardial reperfusion injury, stroke reperfusion injury. Mitigation: antioxidants, reperfusion protocols.

### Replantation Of An Avulsed Tooth

Replacement of an avulsed permanent tooth into its socket after trauma, followed by flexible stabilization and endodontic and periodontal follow-up when indicated. Prognosis depends strongly on extraoral dry time, storage conditions, root maturity, and contamination.

### Repolarization

The return of the membrane potential toward the resting value after depolarization. In neurons and skeletal/cardiac muscle, repolarization is primarily caused by the efflux of potassium through voltage-gated potassium channels and inactivation of sodium channels.

### Reporting Standards

Standards for structured reporting. ACR guidelines, BI-RADS, LI-RADS, PI-RADS.

### Reproductive Organs

The organs involved in reproduction. Female: ovaries (produce eggs and hormones), fallopian tubes (transport eggs, site of fertilization), uterus (nurtures the developing fetus), cervix (lower part of uterus, dilates during labor), vagina (passage for sperm and baby), and vulva (external genitalia).



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## Reproductive Toxicity

Effects on reproduction: infertility, teratogenesis, fetal toxicity, developmental toxicity. Testing required for pharmaceuticals.

## Reproductive Years

The period of a woman's life during which she is capable of conceiving, typically from menarche (first menstrual period, average age 12-13) to menopause (final menstrual period, average age 51).

## Research Ethics

Principles that protect the rights, safety, welfare, privacy, and informed participation of people or animals involved in research.

## Reservoir

A human, animal, or environmental habitat in which an infectious agent normally lives, multiplies, and persists. A reservoir may serve as the source from which the agent is transmitted to a susceptible host.

## Residual Limb

The portion of a limb remaining after amputation. Care includes edema control, skin inspection, shaping, strengthening, desensitization, contracture prevention, and prosthetic preparation.

## Resorption Atelectasis

Atelectasis caused by complete obstruction of an airway, leading to absorption of trapped air by the pulmonary capillaries. Common causes include mucus plugging, foreign body, tumor, and post-surgical shallow breathing. The affected area appears as increased density on CXR with volume loss.

## Respiratory Acidosis

Acid-base disturbance due to accumulation of CO<sub>2</sub> from hypoventilation, lowering pH (acidemia). Causes: respiratory depression (opioids, sedatives, CNS disease), airway obstruction, neuromuscular weakness (GBS, myasthenia), chest wall restriction, severe COPD/asthma, and ventilation-perfusion mismatch.

## Respiratory Alkalosis

Acid-base disturbance from excessive elimination of CO<sub>2</sub> by hyperventilation, raising pH (alkalemia). Causes: anxiety/hyperventilation, hypoxia, pulmonary embolism, sepsis, fever, pain, salicylate toxicity, liver failure, pregnancy, high altitude. Compensation: renal bicarbonate excretion (days).

## Respiratory Changes In Pregnancy

The growing uterus elevates the diaphragm, while hormonal changes increase ventilatory drive. Tidal volume and minute ventilation generally increase, while functional residual capacity decreases.

## Respiratory Depression

Breathing that is abnormally slow or shallow, causing inadequate ventilation and possible carbon-dioxide retention or low oxygen. Medicines, brain disorders, and metabolic illness can cause it.

## Respiratory Distress

Difficulty breathing due to various causes. Assessment: work of breathing (retractions, nasal flaring, tripod position), oxygen saturation, breath sounds. Causes: asthma, COPD, pneumonia, pulmonary embolism, pneumothorax, anaphylaxis, heart failure.

## Respiratory Drive

The neural output that stimulates respiratory muscles and determines ventilation. It is generated by brainstem networks and modified by chemoreceptor input, mechanoreceptors, wakefulness, metabolic state, medications, and behavioral control.

## Respiratory Failure

Inadequate gas exchange resulting in hypoxemia (PaO<sub>2</sub> <60 mmHg), hypercapnia (PaCO<sub>2</sub> >50 mmHg), or both. Type 1 (hypoxemic): V/Q mismatch, shunt, diffusion impairment. Type 2 (hypercapnic): hypoventilation from neuromuscular disease, COPD exacerbation, or opioid overdose.

## Respiratory Health

The proper functioning of the lungs and airways, enabling efficient gas exchange and oxygen delivery to

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the body. Maintaining respiratory health involves avoiding tobacco smoke, minimizing exposure to air pollutants and occupational hazards, and receiving vaccinations against respiratory infections like influenza and pneumococcal disease.

### **Respiratory Infections**

Illnesses caused by pathogens including viruses, bacteria, and fungi that affect the airways and lungs.

### **Respiratory Physiology**

The study of pulmonary function encompassing ventilation (movement of air), gas exchange (diffusion of O<sub>2</sub> and CO<sub>2</sub> across the alveolar-capillary membrane), transport of gases in blood, and regulation of breathing.

### **Respiratory Protection**

Measures and equipment used to reduce inhalation of harmful dusts, fumes, gases, aerosols, or infectious particles.

### **Respiratory Quotient**

The ratio of carbon dioxide production to oxygen consumption for a particular substrate or metabolic state. It differs from the respiratory exchange ratio measured at the mouth and is used in metabolic and ventilatory physiology.

### **Respiratory Rate**

The number of breaths taken per minute. The expected rate varies with age, activity, temperature, illness, and other factors.

### **Respiratory Rehabilitation**

A program of exercise, education, breathing techniques, and self-management that improves function and quality of life in people with chronic respiratory disease.

### **Respiratory Syncytial Virus**

A respiratory virus that commonly causes bronchiolitis and pneumonia in infants and young children. Infection is usually mild in adults but may be severe in infants, older adults, and people with chronic

heart or lung disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

RSV (Respiratory Syncytial Virus)

### **Respiratory Tract Infections**

Infections affecting any part of the respiratory tract, classified by anatomical location into upper respiratory tract infections (URTIs) and lower respiratory tract infections (LRTIs).

### **Respiratory Viruses**

Viruses that cause respiratory tract infections. Major respiratory viruses include influenza, respiratory syncytial virus (RSV), parainfluenza virus, adenovirus, and human metapneumovirus. SARS-CoV-2 causes COVID-19. Symptoms range from mild upper respiratory illness to severe pneumonia.

### **Response Assessment**

Evaluation of treatment response. RECIST criteria for solid tumors. PET response criteria for lymphoma.

### **Response Evaluation Criteria**

RECIST criteria for tumor response. PERCIST for PET.

### **Resting Membrane Potential**

The steady electrical potential difference across the cell membrane of an unstimulated cell, typically -70 mV in neurons, -80 to -90 mV in skeletal and cardiac muscle, and -50 to -60 mV in smooth muscle.

### **Restorative Dentistry**

Specialty of restoring damaged teeth. Procedures: fillings, inlays, onlays, crowns, bridges, implants. Goals: function, aesthetics, durability.

### **Restraint**

Device or medication limiting movement. Physical restraints: vests, wrist restraints, lap traps. Chemical restraints: antipsychotics, benzodiazepines for behavior control. Should be last resort, time-limited, with monitoring. Alternatives: addressing underlying causes, environmental modification.

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### **Restraint-Related Harm**

Physical or psychological injury associated with using a device, medication, or environmental restriction to limit a person's movement. Older adults are at risk of falls, pressure injury, delirium, aspiration, and functional decline; the least restrictive alternatives should be prioritized.

### **Restrictive Cardiomyopathy**

A cardiomyopathy characterized by impaired ventricular relaxation and filling due to stiff, noncompliant myocardium, with preserved systolic function and normal or reduced ventricular volumes. Causes include amyloidosis, sarcoidosis, hemochromatosis, endomyocardial fibrosis, and radiation.

### **Retained Placenta**

Failure of the placenta to deliver after birth within the interval expected for safe management. It may result from failure of separation, abnormal placental attachment, or trapping behind a closed cervix and can cause severe bleeding.

### **Retained Products Of Conception**

Fragments of placental or fetal tissue retained in the uterus after delivery, miscarriage, or abortion. Causes: incomplete placental separation, succenturiate lobe, and placenta accreta. Presents: persistent or heavy bleeding, pain, and fever in the postpartum period.

### **Retention Time**

The time required for a compound to pass through a chromatographic system from injection to detection. In analytical toxicology, comparison with validated standards helps identify compounds, but retention time alone is not definitive identification.

### **Reticular Formation**

A network of interconnected nuclei in the brainstem (midbrain, pons, medulla) that regulates arousal, consciousness, sleep-wake transitions, and alertness (ascending reticular activating system), as well as muscle tone, posture, cardiovascular and respiratory control (vasomotor and respiratory centers), pain modulation, and attention.

### **Reticulocyte Count**

The number or percentage of immature red blood cells in blood. It reflects recent bone-marrow red-cell production and helps assess anemia, especially when interpreted with the hemoglobin and clinical context.

### **Retinal Detachment**

A separation of the neurosensory retina from the underlying retinal pigment epithelium, creating a potential space that fills with fluid and resulting in progressive vision loss in the affected area, and it is classified into three main types based on the underlying mechanism.

### **Retinal Artery Occlusion**

Blockage of a retinal artery causing sudden, usually painless loss of vision. It requires urgent ophthalmic and vascular evaluation because it may indicate a systemic embolic or vascular disorder.

### **Retinal Detachment Repair**

Surgical or pneumatic treatment to close retinal breaks and reattach the retina. Techniques include vitrectomy, scleral buckling, and pneumatic retinopexy, selected according to the type and location of detachment.

### **Retinal Hemorrhages**

Bleeding within the retina, a hallmark finding in abusive head trauma (shaken baby syndrome). Found on dilated fundoscopic examination, often bilateral and multi-layered. Also seen in severe accidental trauma, bleeding disorders, and increased intracranial pressure.

### **Retinal Ischemia**

Inadequate blood flow to the retina, often caused by a retinal artery occlusion or severe vascular disease. It may cause sudden, painless visual loss and requires emergency ophthalmic and vascular assessment; treatment depends on the cause and time of presentation.

### **Retinal Layers**

The retina consists of ten distinct layers that process

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visual information through a complex neural circuit.

### **Retinal Prosthesis**

Experimental device for blindness. Argus II system: camera to processor to electrode array stimulates retina. Indications: retinitis pigmentosa. Provides light perception, pattern recognition.

### **Retinal Tear**

A full-thickness break in the neurosensory retina, often caused by vitreoretinal traction. It can permit fluid to enter the subretinal space and progress to rhegmatogenous retinal detachment; symptomatic tears are generally treated urgently with laser photocoagulation or cryotherapy.

### **Retinal Vein Occlusion**

Obstruction of a retinal vein producing retinal hemorrhages, edema, and variable visual loss. Branch and central forms may cause macular edema, retinal ischemia, and neovascular complications.

### **Retinitis Pigmentosa**

A group of inherited retinal disorders in which rod and cone photoreceptors gradually degenerate. Symptoms may include night blindness, narrowing of the visual field, and progressive loss of vision.

### **Retinopathy Of Prematurity**

Abnormal vascularization of the retina in premature infants, a leading cause of childhood blindness. Affects infants less than 32 weeks gestation and less than 1500 grams. Stages range from mild (avascular retina) to severe (retinal detachment). Screening began at 31-33 weeks corrected gestational age or 4 weeks chronological age.

### **Retinoschisis**

Splitting of the retinal layers, producing a separation between inner and outer retinal tissue. It may be degenerative and peripheral or inherited and juvenile, and can cause visual-field loss, reduced acuity, or complications resembling retinal detachment.

### **Retract (Vascular)**

To pull a vessel or tissue away from an operative field using a surgical retractor.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Retraction (Self-Retaining)**

Holding tissue away from an operative field with a retractor that remains in position without continuous manual support.

**Synonyms:**

Self-Retaining

### **Retractor (Abdominal)**

A surgical instrument used to hold back the abdominal wall or organs to improve access and visibility during an operation.

**Synonyms:**

Abdominal

### **Retractor (Hand)**

A handheld surgical instrument used to hold tissue or an organ away from the operative field.

**Synonyms:**

Hand

### **Retractor (Surgical)**

An instrument used to separate or hold tissues aside during a surgical procedure.

**Synonyms:**

Surgical

### **Retrograde Ejaculation**

Semen enters bladder instead of exiting urethra. Causes: diabetes, surgery, medications. Dry orgasm. Treatment: medications, sperm retrieval for fertility.

### **Retroperitoneal Fibrosis**

Chronic fibroinflammatory tissue formation in the retroperitoneum, often encasing the ureters and great vessels. It can cause hydronephrosis, flank pain, reduced kidney function, hypertension, or lower-limb edema and may be idiopathic, immune-mediated, drug-related, or secondary to malignancy.

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## Retroperitoneal Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the retroperitoneal space, which may result from aortic rupture, anticoagulation therapy, retroperitoneal hematoma following femoral catheterization, trauma, or retroperitoneal neoplasms. Presents with flank pain, abdominal distension, hypotension, and anemia.

## Retroperitoneum

The anatomical space posterior to the peritoneum. It contains the kidneys, adrenal glands, ureters, aorta, and inferior vena cava, as well as portions of the duodenum, pancreas, and colon. Some organs are secondarily retroperitoneal after development. It is divided into anterior pararenal, perirenal, and posterior pararenal spaces.

## Rett Syndrome

An X-linked dominant neurodevelopmental disorder affecting almost exclusively females, caused by mutations in the MECP2 gene.

## Return Of Spontaneous Circulation

Restoration of sustained cardiac mechanical activity after cardiac arrest, evidenced by a palpable pulse or measurable blood pressure and signs of circulation. Post-arrest care addresses oxygenation, ventilation, blood pressure, temperature, neurologic injury, and the cause of arrest.

## Reverberation Artifact

Ultrasound artifact from multiple reflections. Reduced by changing angle, using tissue harmonic imaging.

## Reverse Transcription

Synthesis of DNA from an RNA template by the enzyme reverse transcriptase.

## Reversible Cell Injury

Cellular dysfunction caused by a harmful stimulus that can resolve when the stimulus is removed. Common changes include cellular swelling, fatty change, membrane blebbing, and reduced oxidative phosphorylation without irreversible membrane or nuclear destruction.

## Revision Arthroplasty

Surgical replacement, exchange, or repair of a failed or painful joint prosthesis. Indications include infection, aseptic loosening, instability, periprosthetic fracture, wear, and recurrent dislocation.

## Reye Syndrome

A rare acute encephalopathy with hepatic dysfunction, classically occurring in children recovering from a viral illness. It causes persistent vomiting, altered mental status, cerebral edema, and elevated liver enzymes without primary inflammatory liver failure.

### Synonyms:

Reye Johnson Syndrome (Reye Syndrome)

## Reynolds Pentad

Extension of the Charcot triad to include hypotension and altered mental status representing suppurative cholangitis, a severe life-threatening form of ascending cholangitis. Patients present with high fever, rigors, right upper quadrant pain, jaundice, hypotension, and confusion.

## Rezafungin

A long-acting echinocandin antifungal medicine that inhibits fungal cell-wall synthesis. It is used for selected invasive candidiasis infections; its long duration permits an intermittent dosing schedule under specialist supervision.

## Rh Isoimmunization

Maternal alloantibody production against fetal Rh D-positive red blood cells in an Rh D-negative mother, occurring when fetal RBCs enter the maternal circulation (fetomaternal hemorrhage).

## Rhabdoid Tumor

A highly aggressive malignant tumor of infancy, occurring in the kidney (malignant rhabdoid tumor) or brain (atypical teratoid/rhabdoid tumor), characterized by loss of the SMARCB1 (INI1) gene.

## Rhabdomyolysis

Rhabdomyolysis is rapid skeletal-muscle breakdown releasing myoglobin and electrolytes into blood, po-



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tentially causing hyperkalemia, acute kidney injury, arrhythmia, and compartment complications. crush injury, extreme exertion, seizures, heat illness, and some diseases; it can lead to acute kidney injury and requires prompt medical assessment.

### **Rhabdomyolysis And AKI**

Severe muscle breakdown releases myoglobin and other intracellular contents, potentially causing acute kidney injury, electrolyte abnormalities, and cardiac arrhythmias. Findings may include muscle pain, weakness, dark urine, and elevated creatine kinase; treatment requires urgent assessment and cause-directed fluid and supportive therapy.

### **Rhabdomyoma**

A benign cardiac tumour composed of striated muscle cells, occurring predominantly in infants and children and strongly associated with tuberous sclerosis. It commonly involves the ventricular myocardium and may regress spontaneously, although large or multiple tumours can cause obstruction or arrhythmias.

### **Rhabdomyosarcoma**

Rhabdomyosarcoma is a malignant tumor showing skeletal-muscle differentiation, occurring most often in children but also in adults.

### **Rhegmatogenous Retinal Detachment**

The most common type of retinal detachment, caused by a full-thickness break or tear in the retina that allows liquefied vitreous humor to enter the subretinal space, separating the neurosensory retina from the underlying retinal pigment epithelium.

### **Rhesus (Rh) Factor**

A system of antigens on the surface of red blood cells, especially the D antigen. A person is Rh-positive when the D antigen is present and Rh-negative when it is absent. Rh incompatibility can affect pregnancy and transfusion safety.

**Synonyms:**

Rh

### **Rheumatic Heart Disease**

Valvular damage resulting from acute rheumatic fever, an autoimmune response to Group A streptococcal pharyngitis. Most commonly affects the mitral valve (stenosis/regurgitation), followed by aortic. Prevention through prompt treatment of streptococcal pharyngitis.

### **Rheumatoid Factor**

An autoantibody, usually of the IgM class, directed against part of IgG. It may support a diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis but can also occur in other autoimmune diseases, infections, and healthy people.

### **Rhinencephalon**

The part of the brain concerned chiefly with the sense of smell and related limbic functions.

### **Rhinovirus**

A genus of non-enveloped, positive-sense RNA viruses in the Picornaviridae family. Rhinoviruses are a common cause of the common cold and spread mainly through respiratory secretions and contaminated hands or surfaces.

### **RhoGAM**

Rh immune globulin containing anti-D antibodies, used to prevent Rh isoimmunization in Rh-negative mothers. Administered intramuscularly at 28 weeks gestation and within 72 hours after delivery of an Rh-positive infant. Also given after amniocentesis, chorionic villus sampling, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, or abdominal trauma.

### **Rib**

One of 12 paired, curved bones forming the thoracic cage, protecting the heart, lungs, and great vessels. True ribs (1–7) attach directly to the sternum via costal cartilage. False ribs (8–10) attach indirectly to the sternum via the costal cartilage of rib 7. Floating ribs (11–12) have no anterior attachment.

### **Riboflavin (Vitamin B2)**

A water-soluble vitamin that forms the coenzymes FAD and FMN. These cofactors participate in oxidation-reduction reactions, including



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electron transfer, fatty-acid oxidation, and energy metabolism.

**Synonyms:**

Vitamin B2

**Ribosomal RNA**

RNA component of ribosomes, catalyzing peptide bond formation (peptidyl transferase activity). Eukaryotic ribosome: 60S (28S, 5.8S, 5S rRNAs + proteins) + 40S (18S rRNA + proteins) = 80S. Prokaryotic: 50S (23S, 5S rRNAs) + 30S (16S rRNA) = 70S. rRNA genes are highly conserved, used in phylogenetics.

**Rickettsialpox**

Rickettsialpox is a mite-borne infection caused by *Rickettsia akari*, producing an inoculation eschar followed by fever and a vesicular rash.

**Ridge Preservation**

Socket grafting after extraction to maintain bone volume. Reduces ridge resorption.

**Right Atrium**

Receives deoxygenated blood from superior vena cava, inferior vena cava, and coronary sinus. Smooth posterior part (sinus venosus) and rough anterior auricle with pectinate muscles. The fossa ovalis is the fetal foramen ovale remnant. The SA node pacemaker is near the superior vena cava opening.

**Right Bundle Branch**

A continuation of the bundle of His that travels along the right side of the interventricular septum to the right ventricle. It supplies the right ventricular myocardium and Purkinje fibers. Right bundle branch block (RBBB) occurs when this branch is damaged, causing delayed right ventricular activation.

**Right Coronary Artery**

Arises from the right aortic sinus and travels in the right atrioventricular groove. It supplies the right atrium, right ventricle, SA node (60% of individuals), AV node (85% of individuals), and the inferior wall of the left ventricle.

**Right Coronary Artery Occlusion**

Blockage of the right coronary artery, reducing blood flow to areas of the heart it supplies and potentially causing myocardial infarction or rhythm disturbances.

**Right Heart Failure**

Failure of the right ventricle to adequately pump blood to the lungs, causing systemic venous congestion. Causes include left heart failure (most common), pulmonary hypertension, right ventricular infarction, pulmonary embolism, and constrictive pericarditis. Signs include elevated JVD, peripheral edema, hepatomegaly, and ascites.

**Right Hypochondriac Region**

One of nine abdominal regions in the upper right abdomen, bounded medially by the right midclavicular line and superiorly by the right costal margin. Contains the cecum, appendix, ascending colon, and inferior right liver lobe. Pain here may indicate appendicitis (McBurney's point), cecal pathology, or hepatic disease.

**Right Iliac Region**

Lower right abdomen containing the cecum, appendix, and terminal ileum. McBurney's point (junction of lateral and middle thirds from umbilicus to ASIS) is critical for appendicitis diagnosis. Also significant for evaluating inguinal and femoral hernias, and the right ureter's course.

**Right Lymphatic Duct**

Short lymphatic vessel (approximately 1.5 cm) draining lymph from the right upper quadrant: right arm, right side of the head and neck, and right thorax. Formed by the junction of right jugular, subclavian, and bronchomediastinal trunks, emptying into the right venous angle (junction of right internal jugular and subclavian veins).

**Right Sixth Cranial Nerve Palsy**

Weakness or paralysis of the right abducens nerve (CN VI), causing inability to abduct the right eye and resulting in horizontal diplopia worse at distance and on right gaze.

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### **Right Ureterovesical Calculus**

A stone lodged at the junction of the right ureter and bladder, causing flank pain, hematuria, and urinary urgency or frequency. May require endoscopic or lithotripsy intervention.

### **Right Ventricle**

Receives deoxygenated blood from the right atrium through the tricuspid valve, pumping into the pulmonary trunk via the pulmonary valve. Thinner walls (3-5 mm) than the left ventricle due to low pulmonary resistance.

### **Rigor Mortis**

Post-mortem stiffening of body muscles resulting from loss of ATP synthesis following death. Without ATP, actin and myosin filaments remain permanently cross-linked in a rigid state.

### **Ringing In The Ears**

Perception of ringing, buzzing, hissing, or other sound without an external source, medically called tinnitus. It may be associated with hearing loss, loud-noise exposure, earwax, ear infection, medicines, or jaw disorders. Sudden hearing loss, one-sided symptoms, or pulsatile ringing requires medical evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tinnitus (Ringing In The Ears)

### **Rinne Test**

The Rinne test is a screening test that compares air conduction and bone conduction hearing using a vibrating tuning fork (typically 512 Hz) to help differentiate between conductive and sensorineural hearing loss.

### **RIPE Therapy**

Standard 4-drug regimen for active TB: Rifampin, Isoniazid, Pyrazinamide, Ethambutol. Intensive phase 2 months, continuation phase 4 months (total 6 months). Pyridoxine prevents isoniazid-induced neuropathy.

### **Rippling Muscle Disease**

A rare, benign myopathy characterized by mechanically-induced muscle contractions that spread across the muscle as a visible wave (rippling), typically triggered by stretch, percussion, or movement.

### **Ristocetin-Induced Platelet Aggregation**

A platelet-function assay that evaluates platelet agglutination in the presence of ristocetin, which depends on von Willebrand factor and platelet glycoprotein Ib.

### **River Blindness**

Onchocerciasis, a parasitic infection caused by *Onchocerca volvulus* and transmitted by blackflies. It can cause severe itching, skin disease, and visual impairment.

### **Robot-Assisted Rehabilitation**

Robotic devices for repetitive task training. Upper extremity, lower extremity, gait training. Objective measurement, high repetition.

### **Romberg Test**

The Romberg test is a clinical neurological test used to assess the integrity of the dorsal column-medial lemniscus pathway (proprioception) and the cerebellum in maintaining balance. The test is performed by asking the patient to stand with feet together and eyes open, and then to close the eyes.

### **Romberg's Sign**

Increased unsteadiness when a person stands with the feet together and closes the eyes, suggesting impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

### **Root Caries**

Caries on exposed root surfaces. Common in elderly with recession. Fluoride effective.

### **Root Fracture**

Vertical or horizontal fracture of root. Prognosis depends on location and direction. Vertical root fractures typically require extraction.

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## Rooting Reflex

A primitive reflex present from birth to 3-4 months, triggered by stroking the infant's cheek or corner of the mouth. The infant turns toward the stimulus and opens the mouth, searching for the nipple. Facilitates breastfeeding. Absence may indicate neurologic impairment. Disappears as voluntary feeding develops.

## Ropinirole

A non-ergot dopamine agonist (D2/D3) used for Parkinson disease and restless legs syndrome. Adverse effects: nausea, dizziness, somnolence (sudden sleep attacks), orthostatic hypotension, impulse control disorders (gambling, hypersexuality), hallucinations, and leg edema. Extended-release for once-daily Parkinson dosing.

## Roseola

Roseola infantum is a common viral illness, usually caused by human herpesvirus 6, with several days of high fever followed by a pink trunk rash as the fever resolves; febrile seizures may occur.

### Synonyms:

Sixth Disease (Roseola)

## Rostral

Positioned toward the snout or front of the head; in the brain, it means toward the forehead.

## Rotator Cuff Arthropathy

Glenohumeral joint degeneration associated with chronic, irreparable rotator-cuff deficiency. Superior migration of the humeral head, altered joint mechanics, pain, and loss of elevation may lead to consideration of reverse shoulder arthroplasty.

## Rotavirus

A double-stranded RNA virus that is the leading cause of severe gastroenteritis in children worldwide. The virus has a segmented genome and infects enterocytes of the small intestine. Rotavirus causes profuse watery diarrhea, vomiting, and dehydration. Diagnosis is made by antigen detection in stool.

## Rotavirus Vaccine

An oral live attenuated vaccine that protects infants and young children against severe rotavirus gastroenteritis. The product, schedule, and age limits depend on the immunization program; mild fever or diarrhea may occur.

## Roth Spots

Retinal hemorrhages with pale centers, seen on fundoscopic examination in infective endocarditis. They are a minor criterion in the Duke criteria. Roth spots are caused by immune complex-mediated vasculitis of retinal vessels.

## Rothmund-Thomson Syndrome

A genetically heterogeneous disorder characterized by poikiloderma beginning in infancy, short stature, sparse hair, skeletal abnormalities, juvenile cataracts in some forms, and increased risk of osteosarcoma or other cancers.

## Rouleau

A stack or column of red blood cells, commonly seen in blood with increased plasma proteins.

## Round Pneumonia

Pneumonia appearing as a round opacity on CXR rather than typical consolidation. More common in children and elderly. May mimic lung mass.

## Roundworm

Ascariasis: infection by *Ascaris lumbricoides*, the most common human soil-transmitted helminth, acquired by ingesting eggs from contaminated food/soil.

## Route Of Administration

The path by which a drug enters the body, influencing absorption, onset, bioavailability, and first-pass metabolism. Enteral routes: oral, sublingual, buccal, rectal. Parenteral: intravenous (100 percent bioavailability, immediate onset), intramuscular, subcutaneous, intradermal.

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### **Rovsing Sign**

Physical exam sign of acute appendicitis: palpation of the left lower quadrant elicits pain in the right lower quadrant due to displacement of gas stretching the inflamed appendix. See Appendicitis.

### **RPR/VDRL (Syphilis Serology)**

Nontreponemal blood tests used to screen for and monitor syphilis. Reactive results require interpretation with clinical findings and, usually, a treponemal confirmatory test.

#### **Synonyms:**

Syphilis Serology

### **Rubella Virus**

A togavirus that causes rubella (German measles), a mild febrile illness with rash. The virus is transmitted by respiratory droplets. Rubella is most dangerous during pregnancy, causing congenital rubella syndrome (CRS) with deafness, cataracts, and cardiac defects. Diagnosis involves serology. Treatment is supportive.

### **Rubin Maneuver**

An internal rotational maneuver for shoulder dystocia: the operator inserts a hand and applies pressure to the posterior aspect of the anterior fetal shoulder, rotating it toward the fetal chest (adducting the shoulders). This reduces the bisacromial diameter and disimpacts the anterior shoulder from the pubic symphysis.

### **Rubinstein-Taybi Syndrome**

A genetic developmental disorder associated with characteristic facial features, short stature, broad thumbs and toes, and intellectual disability. It is commonly caused by pathogenic variants in CREBBP or EP300.

### **Rumination Disorder**

Recurrent effortless regurgitation of recently ingested food, followed by rechewing, reswallowing, or spitting, without the retching typical of vomiting. It can cause weight loss, malnutrition, and dental complications.

### **Ruptured Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm**

A tear through an abdominal aortic aneurysm causing internal bleeding, shock, and usually sudden abdominal or back pain. It requires emergency repair.

### **Russell-Silver Syndrome**

A congenital growth disorder involving prenatal and postnatal growth restriction, relative macrocephaly, triangular face, body asymmetry, and feeding difficulty. It is often associated with abnormalities of genomic imprinting on chromosomes 7 or 11.

### **Rx**

Prescription or treatment. Symbol derives from Latin "requirere" (to take). Also used as abbreviation for remedy. Rx symbol: Rx or %x;.

### **Reverse Trendelenburg Position**

A supine position in which the head and upper body are elevated above the feet.

### **Rapid Gastric Emptying**

Abnormally rapid movement of food from the stomach into the small intestine, sometimes called dumping syndrome.

### **Rectal Cancer**

Cancer that develops in the tissues of the rectum.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Rectal

### **Recurrent Breast Cancer**

Breast cancer that returns after a period in which it was undetectable.

### **Residual Limb Pain**

Pain in the remaining portion of a limb after amputation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Stump Pain

### **Retinal Diseases**

Disorders that damage the retina, the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye.

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### Ringworm Of The Body

A contagious fungal infection causing an itchy, ring-shaped rash on the skin.

### Ringworm Of The Scalp

A fungal infection of the scalp and hair that can cause scaling, broken hairs, and hair loss.

### Rotator Cuff Injury

Damage to one or more tendons or muscles that stabilize and move the shoulder.

### Rales

Crackling or bubbling sounds heard in the lungs, often caused by fluid or narrowed airways.

### Retinitis

Inflammation of the retina that may impair vision.

### Romberg Sign

Loss of balance when standing with the feet together and the eyes closed, suggesting impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

### Rule Of Nines

A method for estimating the percentage of body-surface area affected by burns.

### Rongeur

A strong, jawed surgical instrument used to bite and remove small pieces of bone or other hard tissue.

### Rabies Virus

The virus that causes rabies, a usually fatal viral infection of the central nervous system transmitted most often through the saliva of an infected animal.

### Radioactive Iodine Uptake Test

A nuclear medicine test that measures how much radioactive iodine the thyroid gland absorbs. It helps evaluate hyperthyroidism and some thyroid disorders.

### Radioisotope (Radionuclide)

An unstable isotope that emits radiation as it decays; radioisotopes are used in medical imaging, diagnosis, and selected treatments.

#### Synonyms:

Radionuclide

### Rale (Rhonchus)

An abnormal sound heard through a stethoscope during breathing, caused by air moving through fluid, mucus, narrowed airways, or abnormal lung tissue.

#### Synonyms:

Rhonchus

### Renal Dialysis

A treatment that removes waste products and excess fluid from the blood when the kidneys cannot do so adequately, using haemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis.

### Retinol (Vitamin A)

A fat-soluble vitamin required for vision, epithelial health, immune function, and normal growth; deficiency may cause night blindness and xerophthalmia.

#### Synonyms:

Vitamin A

### Revascularisation

Restoration of blood flow to an organ or limb by a procedure such as angioplasty, stenting, or surgical bypass.

### Root Canal Therapy

Dental treatment in which infected or inflamed pulp is removed from a tooth, the canal is cleaned and sealed, and the tooth is restored.

### Roth's Spots

Small retinal haemorrhages with pale centres, associated with conditions such as infective endocarditis, severe anaemia, leukaemia, and diabetes.

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### **Radionuclide Heart Scan**

A nuclear medicine study that uses a radioactive tracer to evaluate myocardial blood flow, heart muscle viability, or ventricular function.

### **Rasp**

A roughened surgical instrument used to file, shape, or smooth bone or other hard tissue.

### **Red Blood Cells**

Blood cells that contain hemoglobin and transport oxygen from the lungs to tissues while carrying some carbon dioxide back to the lungs.

### **Reed-Sternberg Cells**

Large abnormal cells derived from B lymphocytes and characteristic of classic Hodgkin lymphoma.

### **Reflexes**

Automatic, rapid responses to stimuli mediated through neural pathways called reflex arcs.

### **Renal Corpuscle**

The filtration unit at the beginning of a nephron, consisting of the glomerulus enclosed by Bowman capsule.

### **Renal Pyramids**

Cone-shaped structures in the renal medulla that contain tubules and collecting ducts and drain urine toward the renal papillae.

### **Repetitive Strain Injury**

Pain or dysfunction caused by repeated forceful movements, sustained positions, or overuse of muscles, tendons, nerves, or other tissues.

### **Resectoscope**

An endoscopic surgical instrument with a viewing system and working loop used to remove or cauterize tissue, especially during prostate or bladder procedures.

### **Resorption**

The removal and absorption of tissue, especially the

breakdown of bone by osteoclasts.

### **Reticular Activating System**

A network involving the brainstem reticular formation and related structures that helps regulate wakefulness, alertness, attention, and sleep-wake transitions.

### **Retinoscope**

An instrument that shines light into the eye to help determine refractive error.

### **Rh Incompatibility**

An immune reaction that can occur when an Rh-negative pregnant person carries an Rh-positive fetus and forms antibodies against fetal red blood cells. Anti-D immune globulin can prevent sensitization.

### **Rods**

Retinal photoreceptor cells that provide vision in dim light and contribute to peripheral vision but do not detect color.

### **Rubeola**

Measles, a highly contagious viral illness caused by measles virus and characterized by fever, cough, conjunctivitis, and a widespread maculopapular rash.

#### **Synonyms:**

Measles (Rubeola)

### **Radius Fracture**

A break in the radius, one of the two bones of the forearm, often occurring near the wrist after a fall onto an outstretched hand.

### **Rotator Cuff Tear**

A partial or complete tear of one or more tendons stabilizing the shoulder, causing pain, weakness, and difficulty raising or rotating the arm.

### **Radial Nerve Palsy**

Dysfunction of the radial nerve causing weakness of wrist and finger extension, often producing wrist drop, with sensory loss over part of the back of the hand in some cases.



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### **Radiation Proctitis**

Inflammation and injury of the rectum after pelvic radiation therapy, causing rectal pain, urgency, diarrhea, mucus, or bleeding.

### **Rhinorrhea**

Excessive watery or mucoid discharge from the nose, commonly caused by infection, allergy, irritants, or changes in temperature.

### **Rib Fracture**

A break in one or more ribs, usually causing localized chest pain worsened by breathing, coughing, or movement and sometimes associated with injury to underlying organs.

### **Retrograde Amnesia**

Loss of memory for events that occurred before an injury, illness, or other triggering event, with variable preservation of more remote memories.

### **Rabeprazole**

Rabeprazole is a proton-pump inhibitor that irreversibly suppresses gastric H<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup>-ATPase; it treats reflux and peptic-ulcer disease and supports *Helicobacter pylori* eradication.

### **Rabies Vaccine**

A medical term referring to rabies vaccine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Raclopride**

Raclopride is a research radioligand that binds dopamine D2 receptors and is used in brain-imaging studies of dopamine signaling.

### **Radiation Dosage**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radiation dosage. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radiation Exposure**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radiation exposure. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up

depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radiation Field**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radiation field. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radiation Leukemia**

A neoplasm involving radiation leukemia. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Radiation Oncologists**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radiation oncologists. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radiation Tolerance**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radiation tolerance. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radical Cystoprostatectomy**

radical cystoprostatectomy is used in relation to radical cystoprostatectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radical Hysterectomy**

radical hysterectomy is used in relation to radical hysterectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radical Lymphadenectomy**

radical lymphadenectomy is used in relation to radical lymphadenectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radical Mastectomy**

radical mastectomy is used in relation to radical mastectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radical Nephrectomy**

radical nephrectomy is used in relation to radical nephrectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treat-

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ment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radicular Cyst**

A medical term referring to radicular cyst. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Radiodermatitis**

Radiodermatitis is skin injury caused by ionizing radiation, ranging from redness and hair loss to chronic ulceration, fibrosis, or cancer risk.

### **Radioembolisation**

A medical procedure, device, or treatment involving radioembolisation. Its purpose, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radioimmunodetection**

A biological or biochemical term involving radioimmunodetection. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Radioimmunoguided Surgery**

radioimmunoguided surgery is used in relation to radioimmunoguided surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radioimmunotherapy**

radioimmunotherapy is used in relation to radioimmunotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radioisotope**

A biological or biochemical term involving radioisotope. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Radiologic Health**

Radiologic health concerns protection from unnecessary ionizing radiation while preserving the diagnostic or therapeutic benefit of medical imaging.

### **Radiologic Response**

A clinical condition or finding involving radiologic response. Its features, causes, evaluation, and man-

agement depend on the clinical context.

### **Radiometry**

A medical term referring to radiometry. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Radionuclide Angiography**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to radionuclide angiography. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Radionuclide Generator**

radionuclide generator is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Radionuclide Imaging**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to radionuclide imaging. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Radioprotective Agent**

A radioprotective agent reduces tissue injury from ionizing radiation by limiting DNA damage, scavenging radicals, or supporting repair.

### **Radiosurgery**

radiosurgery is used in relation to radiosurgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radiotherapy Bolus**

radiotherapy bolus is used in relation to radiotherapy bolus during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radiotherapy Dosage**

radiotherapy dosage is used in relation to radiotherapy dosage during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Radon**

A biological or biochemical term involving radon. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and

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physiological process.

### **Raffinose**

Raffinose is a plant oligosaccharide that humans digest poorly and that can be fermented by gut bacteria, causing gas in some people.

### **Rahnella**

rahnella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rahnella Aquatilis**

rahnella aquatilis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rale**

A rale, or crackle, is an abnormal discontinuous breath sound produced by fluid, collapsed airways, or opening of small airways during breathing.

### **Raloxifene Hydrochloride**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called raloxifene hydrochloride. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Ralstonia**

ralstonia is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Ralstonia Mannitolilytica**

ralstonia mannitolilytica is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Ralstonia Pickettii**

ralstonia pickettii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, speci-

men source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Raltegravir Potassium**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called raltegravir potassium. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Raltitrexed**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called raltitrexed. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Ramipril**

Ramipril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension, heart failure, and cardiovascular risk reduction; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

### **Ramucirumab**

A medical term referring to ramucirumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Random Allocation**

A biological or biochemical term involving random allocation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Randomization Validation**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to randomization validation. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Ranibizumab**

A medical term referring to ranibizumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ranolazine**

Ranolazine is an antianginal drug that inhibits the late sodium current in cardiac cells and reduces chronic angina without substantially lowering heart

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rate or blood pressure; QT prolongation and drug interactions require caution.

### **Ranpirnase**

A medical term referring to ranpirnase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Raoultella**

raoultella is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Raoultella Planticola**

A biomedical term referring to raoultella planticola; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Raoultella Terrigena**

A biomedical term referring to raoultella terrigena; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Raphe Nuclei**

The raphe nuclei are brainstem groups of neurons that produce serotonin and influence mood, pain, sleep, arousal, and autonomic functions.

### **Rare Diseases**

A clinical condition or finding involving rare diseases. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ras Peptide**

ras peptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in ras peptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **Ratio**

A ratio compares two quantities by division, such as a measurement of risk, concentration, or body proportions.

### **Rationalization**

A biological or biochemical term involving rationalization. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Rauscher Virus**

rauscher virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Rauwolfia Alkaloid**

Rauwolfia alkaloids are plant-derived compounds that deplete or reduce sympathetic neurotransmission and were historically used for hypertension.

### **Ravuconazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ravuconazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Razoxane**

Razoxane is a topoisomerase-II inhibitor related to dexrazoxane and studied or used historically for selected anticancer or cardioprotective purposes.

### **Reaction**

A biological or biochemical term involving reaction. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Reactive Hypoglycemia**

Reactive hypoglycemia is low blood glucose occurring after eating, often several hours later, with shakiness, sweating, hunger, or weakness and requiring evaluation of causes.

### **Reagent**

A reagent is a chemical or biological substance used to cause or detect a reaction in laboratory testing, research, or manufacturing.

### **Reality Testing**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to reality

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testing. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Rebeccamycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called rebeccamycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Receive**

To receive means to be given or take in a treatment, substance, signal, transplant, specimen, or other intervention or material.

### **Receptor Binding**

receptor binding is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Recombinant**

A biological or biochemical term involving recombinant. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Recombinant Protein**

recombinant protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Recombinase**

A biological or biochemical term involving recombinase. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Recombinational Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to recombinational repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Record**

A health record is a documented account of a person's history, findings, tests, diagnoses, treatments, decisions, and outcomes.

### **Recreation Therapy**

recreation therapy is used in relation to recreation therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Rectal**

Rectal means relating to the rectum, the final section of the large intestine before the anal canal.

### **Rectal Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving rectal carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Rectal Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving rectal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rectal Fistula**

A rectal fistula is an abnormal tract connecting the rectum with skin or another organ, often causing drainage, infection, or passage of stool through an abnormal route.

### **Rectal Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving rectal hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rectal Mucositis**

Rectal mucositis is inflammation and injury of the rectal lining, often after radiation, chemotherapy, infection, inflammatory disease, or trauma.

### **Rectal Necrosis**

Rectal necrosis is death of rectal tissue from inadequate blood flow, severe inflammation, infection, pressure, or another destructive process.

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### **Rectal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving rectal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Rectal Obstruction**

A clinical condition or finding involving rectal obstruction. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rectal Perforation**

A biological or biochemical term involving rectal perforation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Rectal Polyposis**

Rectal polyposis is the presence of multiple polyps in the rectum, which may be sporadic or part of an inherited syndrome and can increase cancer risk.

### **Rectal Route**

The rectal route administers a medicine or fluid through the anus into the rectum, where it may act locally or be absorbed systemically.

### **Rectal Stenosis**

A clinical condition or finding involving rectal stenosis. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rectal Tenesmus**

Rectal tenesmus is a persistent or urgent feeling of needing to pass stool despite an empty or nearly empty rectum, caused by inflammation, infection, mass, or motility disorder.

### **Rectosigmoid Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving rectosigmoid neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Rectus Abdominis**

The rectus abdominis is a paired abdominal muscle that flexes the trunk, stabilizes the pelvis, and helps compress abdominal contents.

### **Recurrent Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving recurrent disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Recurrent Fractures**

A clinical condition or finding involving recurrent fractures. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Red Nucleus**

The red nucleus is a midbrain structure involved in motor coordination and connections with the cerebellum and spinal cord.

### **Reducing Agents**

Reducing agents donate electrons in chemical reactions and can alter oxidation state; they are used in laboratory chemistry, biology, and manufacturing.

### **Reducing Diet**

A reducing diet is a calorie-controlled eating pattern intended to reduce body weight; safe plans should provide adequate nutrients and account for health conditions.

### **Reductase Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving reductase deficiency. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Reduviidae**

A biomedical term referring to reduviidae; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Referral**

A medical term referring to referral. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reflex**

A reflex is a rapid, involuntary response to a stimulus mediated through a neural or physiologic pathway.



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### **Reflex Epilepsy**

Reflex epilepsy is epilepsy in which specific stimuli such as flashing light, sound, reading, or touch reliably trigger seizures.

### **Refractive Error**

A refractive error occurs when the eye does not focus light correctly on the retina, causing nearsightedness, farsightedness, astigmatism, or presbyopia.

### **Refractometer**

A refractometer measures how much light bends through a substance and is used for fluid concentration, optical properties, or eye refraction.

### **Refractometry**

A medical term referring to refractometry. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Refractory Anemia**

Refractory anemia is an older term for anemia that persists despite usual treatment and may refer to a myelodysplastic syndrome or another underlying disorder.

### **Refractory Cancer**

A neoplasm involving refractory cancer. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Refractory Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving refractory disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Regeneration**

regeneration is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Regional**

A biological or biochemical term involving regional. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and

physiological process.

### **Regional Chemotherapy**

regional chemotherapy is used in relation to regional chemotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Regulatory Authority**

A regulatory authority is a government or official body that sets and enforces standards for medicines, devices, facilities, professionals, or public health.

### **Regulatory Gene**

regulatory gene is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Reifenstein Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving reifenstein syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Reiki**

Reiki is a complementary practice involving light touch or hands near the body; evidence for treating disease is limited and it should not replace effective medical care.

### **Relaxation**

A biological or biochemical term involving relaxation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Relaxin**

Relaxin is a reproductive hormone that helps remodel connective tissue and may contribute to cervical, pelvic, and vascular changes during pregnancy.

### **Religion**

A biological or biochemical term involving religion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

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## Removal Technique

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to removal technique; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Renal Adenoma

A renal adenoma is a usually benign kidney tumor, often discovered incidentally; its size, imaging features, and growth determine whether follow-up is needed.

## Renal Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving renal carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Renal Circulation

A biological or biochemical term involving renal circulation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Renal Cyst

A renal cyst is a fluid-filled sac in or on the kidney, commonly benign but sometimes complex or associated with inherited cystic disease.

## Renal Function

A biological or biochemical term involving renal function. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## Renal Glomerulus

A renal glomerulus is a tuft of capillaries within a nephron that filters blood to begin urine formation.

## Renal Hamartoma

A renal hamartoma is a benign disorganized overgrowth of mature tissues in the kidney, sometimes used to describe an angiomyolipoma-like lesion.

## Renal Hypertension

renal hypertension is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentra-

tion, pathway, or clinical context.

## Renal Hypertrophy

Renal hypertrophy is enlargement of kidney tissue, often compensating for loss or reduced function of the other kidney but sometimes caused by disease.

## Renal Insufficiency

Renal insufficiency is reduced kidney function that impairs waste removal, fluid and electrolyte balance, acid handling, or hormone production.

## Renal Necrosis

Renal necrosis is death of kidney tissue caused by severe ischemia, toxins, infection, obstruction, or other injury and can cause acute kidney failure.

## Renal Oncocytoma

A renal oncocytoma is a usually benign kidney tumor arising from oncocytic cells; imaging may not always distinguish it reliably from renal cancer.

## Renal Parenchyma

Renal parenchyma is the functional kidney tissue containing nephrons and supporting structures that filter blood and produce urine.

## Renal Reabsorption

A clinical condition or finding involving renal reabsorption. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Renal Sarcoma

A neoplasm involving renal sarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Renal Tubule Acidosis

renal tubule acidosis is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

## Renaut Body

A Renaut body is a specialized cluster of cells in

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the peripheral nerve endoneurium, associated with pressure sensitivity and sometimes nerve pathology.

### **Renshaw Cell**

renshaw cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Reoviridae**

reoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Reoviridae Infection**

reoviridae infection is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Repeat Surgery**

repeat surgery is used in relation to repeat surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Replication Initiation**

A biological or biochemical term involving replication initiation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Replicon**

A medical term referring to replicon. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reporter Gene**

reporter gene is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Repression**

A biological or biochemical term involving repression. Its role depends on the relevant cells,

molecules, and physiological process.

### **Reproduction**

reproduction is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Reproduction Spores**

reproduction spores is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

### **Reproductive Behavior**

Reproductive behavior includes behaviors involved in courtship, mating, pair bonding, pregnancy, parenting, or sexual response and is influenced by biology and environment.

### **Reproductive History**

Reproductive history records pregnancies, births, miscarriages, abortions, menstrual function, fertility, contraception, and related conditions relevant to health assessment.

### **Reproductive Process**

A reproductive process is a biological event involved in gamete production, fertilization, implantation, pregnancy, birth, or development of offspring.

### **Reproductive Technique**

A reproductive technique is a medical or laboratory method used to assist conception, preserve fertility, diagnose reproductive disease, or manage pregnancy.

### **Reprogram**

To reprogram a cell means to alter its gene-expression state so it acquires a different developmental potential or function.

### **Reptiles**

A medical term referring to reptiles. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### Research Activity

Research activity is systematic work that generates or evaluates evidence through observation, experimentation, analysis, or synthesis.

### Research Design

Research design is the planned structure of a study, including its question, participants, interventions, measurements, comparisons, and analysis.

### Research Personnel

Research personnel are people who design, conduct, coordinate, monitor, analyze, or support a research study according to its protocol and ethical requirements.

### Research Study

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### Resectable

A medical term referring to resectable. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Reserpine

Reserpine depletes neuronal catecholamines and serotonin by inhibiting vesicular monoamine transport; it was formerly used for hypertension and psychosis but is now rarely used because of depression, parkinsonism, and hypotension.

### Residential Mobility

Residential mobility is movement between homes or communities and can affect continuity of care, social support, exposure, and health access.

### Residual Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving residual neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Residual Risk

Residual risk is the chance of harm that remains

after preventive measures, treatment, screening, or controls have been applied.

### Residual Tumor

A neoplasm involving residual tumor. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Resin

A medical term referring to resin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Resiquimod

A medical term referring to resiquimod. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Resistance Training

A medical term referring to resistance training. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Resistant Starch

A medical term referring to resistant starch. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Respiratory Burst

A respiratory burst is rapid production of reactive oxygen species by activated phagocytes to help destroy engulfed microorganisms.

### Respiratory Disorder

A clinical condition or finding involving respiratory disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Respiratory Infection

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving respiratory infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### Respiratory Muscle

respiratory muscle refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location

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and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Respiratory Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving respiratory neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Respiratory Paralysis**

Respiratory paralysis is failure of the muscles needed for breathing because of nerve, muscle, brainstem, toxin, or spinal-cord dysfunction and is an emergency.

### **Respiratory Therapy**

respiratory therapy is used in relation to respiratory therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Respiratory Transport**

Respiratory transport is movement of oxygen and carbon dioxide between lungs, blood, and tissues, largely through hemoglobin and dissolved gas.

### **Respirovirus**

respirovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Respite Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to respite care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Restlessness**

Restlessness is an uncomfortable need to move or inability to remain still, caused by anxiety, akathisia, restless-legs syndrome, pain, stimulants, withdrawal, or medical illness.

### **Restriction Mapping**

A biological or biochemical term involving restriction mapping. Its role depends on the relevant cells,

molecules, and physiological process.

### **Resveratrol**

A medical term referring to resveratrol. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Retainer**

A medical term referring to retainer. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticular Dermis**

A medical term referring to reticular dermis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticulin**

A medical term referring to reticulin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticulocyte**

A medical term referring to reticulocyte. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticulocytopenia**

A medical term referring to reticulocytopenia. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticulocytosis**

Reticulocytosis is an increased number of immature red blood cells in blood, usually indicating stimulated marrow production after blood loss or hemolysis.

### **Reticuloendothelial System**

A medical term referring to reticuloendothelial system. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Reticulophagy**

A medical term referring to reticulophagy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **Reticulosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving reticulosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Reticulum**

A medical term referring to reticulum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Retina Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving retina disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Retina Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving retina hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Retinal Cone**

A retinal cone is a light-sensitive photoreceptor specialized for color and detailed vision in brighter conditions.

### **Retinal Damage**

A medical term referring to retinal damage. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Retinal Degeneration**

retinal degeneration is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Retinal Dysplasia**

Retinal dysplasia is abnormal development and organization of the retina, which can impair vision and occur with congenital, genetic, or prenatal disorders.

### **Retinal Dystrophy**

Retinal dystrophy is progressive degeneration of retinal cells, often inherited, causing night blindness, visual-field loss, and eventual reduced vision.

### **Retinal Fold**

A retinal fold is a crease or ridge in the retina caused by traction, developmental abnormality, detachment, swelling, or another ocular process.

### **Retinal Ganglion**

A biological or biochemical term involving retinal ganglion. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Retinal Macula**

The macula is the central region of the retina responsible for detailed straight-ahead vision, reading, and color discrimination.

### **Retinal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving retinal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Retinal Perforation**

A biological or biochemical term involving retinal perforation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Retinal Pigment**

Retinal pigment refers to melanin-containing pigment in the retinal pigment epithelium, which supports photoreceptors and absorbs excess light.

### **Retinal Vasculitis**

Retinal vasculitis is inflammation of retinal blood vessels, which can cause hemorrhage, leakage, ischemia, vision loss, and systemic inflammatory disease.

### **Retinaldehyde**

A medical term referring to retinaldehyde. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Retinoblastoma Protein**

retinoblastoma protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function.



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tion in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Retirement**

Retirement is withdrawal from regular employment or a career; changes in income, activity, social contact, and health coverage can affect wellbeing.

### **Retortamonas Intestinalis**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to retortamonas intestinalis. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Retractile Testis**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to retractile testis. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Retreatment**

retreatment is used in relation to retreatment during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Retrobulbar Hemorrhage**

A clinical condition or finding involving retrobulbar hemorrhage. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Retroesophageal**

Retroesophageal means located behind the esophagus, such as a mass, lymph node, vessel, or collection in the posterior mediastinum.

### **Retrognathia**

Retrognathia is backward positioning of the lower jaw relative to the upper jaw and may affect facial structure, bite, airway, or sleep breathing.

### **Retrograde Degeneration**

retrograde degeneration is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Retroperitoneal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving retroperitoneal neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Retroperitoneal Space**

The retroperitoneal space is the area behind the peritoneal lining containing the kidneys, adrenal glands, pancreas, parts of the bowel, vessels, nerves, and lymphatics.

### **Retrospective Studies**

Retrospective studies examine existing records or past exposures and outcomes; they are efficient but vulnerable to missing data, bias, and confounding.

### **Retrotracheal**

Retrotracheal means located behind the trachea, such as a mass, lymph node, vessel, or collection in the posterior mediastinum.

### **Retrotransposition**

A biological or biochemical term involving retrotransposition. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Retroviral Vector**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called retroviral vector. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Retroviridae**

retroviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Retroviridae Infection**

retroviridae infection is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

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### Revascularization Surgery

revascularization surgery is used in relation to revascularization surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### Reversal Learning

Reversal learning is the ability to change a learned response when the previously rewarded or correct choice is no longer so.

### R-Factor

A medical term referring to r-factor. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rgs Proteins

rgs proteins is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### Rhabdoviridae

rhabdoviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Rhamnose

Rhamnose is a deoxy sugar found in plants and bacterial cell walls and used in biochemical and microbiologic research.

### Rhesus Incompatibility

Rhesus incompatibility occurs when an RhD-negative pregnant person forms antibodies against RhD-positive fetal red cells, risking haemolytic disease in a later or affected pregnancy; anti-D immunoglobulin prevents sensitization.

### Rheumatic Chorea

Rheumatic chorea is involuntary, irregular movement caused by an autoimmune reaction after group A streptococcal infection and is a manifestation of acute rheumatic fever.

### Rheumatoid Nodule

A rheumatoid nodule is a firm inflammatory lump under the skin or near a joint in rheumatoid arthritis, often over pressure points.

### Rhinocephaly

Rhinocephaly is a rare congenital facial-development abnormality with a proboscis-like structure and severe forebrain malformation.

### Rhinology

A medical term referring to rhinology. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rhinovirus A

rhinovirus A is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Rhinovirus C

rhinovirus C is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Rhizobiaceae

A medical term referring to rhizobiaceae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rhizobium

A medical term referring to rhizobium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rhizomucor

A medical term referring to rhizomucor. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rhizomucor Pusillus

A medical term referring to rhizomucor pusillus. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rhizopus

A medical term referring to rhizopus. Its clinical

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meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhizopus Oryzae**

A medical term referring to rhizopus oryzae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhizoxin**

Rhizoxin is a microtubule-disrupting compound produced by some fungi and studied as an experimental cytotoxic or anticancer agent.

### **Rhodium**

A medical term referring to rhodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodobacteraceae**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving rhodobacteraceae; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Rhodococcus**

rhodococcus is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Rhodococcus Equi**

rhodococcus equi is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

### **Rhodopseudomonas**

A medical term referring to rhodopseudomonas. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodopsin**

A medical term referring to rhodopsin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodospirillaceae**

A medical term referring to rhodospirillaceae. Its

clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodospirillales**

A medical term referring to rhodospirillales. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodospirillum**

A medical term referring to rhodospirillum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhodotorula Glutinis**

A medical term referring to rhodotorula glutinis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rhombencephalon**

The rhombencephalon is the embryonic hindbrain, which develops into the pons, medulla, cerebellum, and related structures.

### **Riboflavin Assay**

A diagnostic or laboratory method related to riboflavin assay. Results are interpreted with the method, reference range, and clinical findings.

### **Riboflavin Deficiency**

A clinical condition or finding involving riboflavin deficiency. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ribonuclease**

A biological or biochemical term involving ribonuclease. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ribonuclease H**

A biological or biochemical term involving ribonuclease h. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ribonuclease Iii**

A biological or biochemical term involving ribonu-

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lease iii. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ribonucleoprotein**

ribonucleoprotein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Ribonucleoside**

A biological or biochemical term involving ribonucleoside. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ribonucleotide Reductase**

Ribonucleotide reductase converts ribonucleotides to deoxyribonucleotides needed for DNA synthesis and repair.

### **Ribonucleotides**

A biological or biochemical term involving ribonucleotides. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Ribophagy**

Ribophagy is selective autophagic degradation of ribosomes, allowing cells to recycle ribosomal components when nutrients or growth conditions change.

### **Ribose**

A medical term referring to ribose. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ribosomal Protein**

ribosomal protein is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Ribosome Subunit**

A medical term referring to ribosome subunit. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ribostamycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ribostamycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Richter's Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving richter's syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ricin**

Ricin is a highly toxic plant protein that blocks protein synthesis; ingestion, inhalation, or injection can cause severe organ injury and death.

### **Rickettsia Felis**

rickettsia felis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rickettsia Infections**

rickettsia infections is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rickettsia Japonica**

rickettsia japonica is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rickettsia Prowazekii**

rickettsia prowazekii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rickettsia Rickettsii**

rickettsia rickettsii is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

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### **Rickettsia Typhi**

rickettsia typhi is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Rickettsiaceae**

rickettsiaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Ridaforolimus**

Ridaforolimus is an investigational mTOR inhibitor studied for anticancer effects by reducing growth and proliferation signaling.

### **Ridged Nail**

A ridged nail has longitudinal or transverse grooves in its surface, which may result from aging, trauma, inflammation, nutritional problems, or systemic disease.

### **Riedel's Thyroiditis**

Riedel's thyroiditis is rare fibrosing inflammation that makes the thyroid hard and can extend into nearby tissues, causing compression or hypothyroidism.

### **Rieger Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving rieger syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rifabutin**

A medical term referring to rifabutin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rifampin**

Rifampin is a rifamycin antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA-dependent RNA polymerase and is a key component of tuberculosis treatment; it causes orange body fluids and has many drug interactions and hepatotoxicity risk.

### **Rifamycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called rifamycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Rifaximin**

Rifaximin is a minimally absorbed rifamycin antibiotic used for selected intestinal infections, prevention of recurrent hepatic encephalopathy, and some diarrhoeal syndromes; indication and resistance patterns guide use.

### **Right Eye**

The right eye is the ocular organ on the right side of the body, containing the cornea, lens, retina, optic nerve, and supporting tissues.

### **Right Kidney**

The right kidney is the kidney on the right side of the abdomen that filters blood, regulates fluid and electrolytes, and produces urine and hormones.

### **Right Lung**

The right lung is the three-lobed lung on the right side of the chest that exchanges oxygen and carbon dioxide.

### **Righting Reflex**

The righting reflex is an automatic response that restores head and body orientation when balance or position changes.

### **Rigosertib Sodium**

Rigosertib sodium is an investigational anticancer agent studied for effects on cell-cycle regulation and survival signaling.

### **Rilotumumab**

A medical term referring to rilotumumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rilpivirine**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called rilpivirine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse

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effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Riluzole**

A medical term referring to riluzole. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rimantadine**

A medical term referring to rimantadine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ring Chromosome**

ring chromosome is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Risedronate Sodium**

A medical term referring to risedronate sodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Risk**

Risk is the probability of an unwanted event or outcome, considered together with its severity and the circumstances that influence it.

### **Risk Adjustment**

Risk adjustment accounts for differences in baseline patient characteristics so outcomes or payments can be compared more fairly across groups.

### **Risk Factors**

Risk factors are characteristics, exposures, behaviors, or conditions associated with increased likelihood of developing a disease or adverse outcome.

### **Risk-Taking**

Risk-taking is behavior involving deliberate or inadvertent exposure to possible harm, influenced by perception, reward, development, mental health, and circumstances.

### **Risperidone**

Risperidone is an atypical antipsychotic that blocks dopamine and serotonin receptors and treats

schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and selected severe behavioral symptoms; hyperprolactinaemia, metabolic effects, movement disorders, and sedation may occur.

### **Ristocetin**

Ristocetin is an antibiotic used in laboratory testing of platelet aggregation and von Willebrand factor, not as a routine modern treatment.

### **Ritonavir**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called ritonavir. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Ritual**

A ritual is a repeated, structured behavior or ceremony; repetitive rituals may also occur as compulsions in obsessive-compulsive disorder.

### **Rituximab**

Rituximab is a monoclonal antibody against CD20 that depletes B cells and is used for B-cell malignancies and selected autoimmune diseases; infusion reactions, infections, hepatitis-B reactivation, and rare PML are important risks.

### **Rivaroxaban**

Rivaroxaban is an oral direct factor Xa inhibitor used to prevent or treat venous thromboembolism and reduce stroke risk in selected atrial fibrillation; bleeding and renal-function-dependent dosing are important considerations.

### **RNA Binding**

A medical term referring to rna binding. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Biosynthesis**

A medical term referring to rna biosynthesis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Degradation**

A biological or biochemical term involving rna degra-



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dation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **RNA Folding**

A medical term referring to rna folding. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Helicase**

A medical term referring to rna helicase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Interference**

A medical term referring to rna interference. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Splicing**

A medical term referring to rna splicing. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Transport**

A medical term referring to rna transport. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **RNA Virus**

RNA virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **RNase P**

A medical term referring to rnase p. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Robinow Syndrome**

A clinical condition or finding involving robinow syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rod Photoreceptor**

rod photoreceptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute

to disease.

### **Rofecoxib**

Rofecoxib is a selective COX-2 anti-inflammatory drug withdrawn in many countries because of increased cardiovascular risk.

### **Romidepsin**

A medical term referring to romidepsin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Romiplostim**

A medical term referring to romiplostim. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ronnel**

Ronnel is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Ropivacaine**

A medical term referring to ropivacaine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ropivacaine Hydrochloride**

A medical term referring to ropivacaine hydrochloride. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rose Bengal**

Rose bengal is a dye used in eye-surface testing and laboratory or diagnostic procedures; it highlights damaged or poorly protected conjunctival cells.

### **Roseolovirus**

roseolovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Roseomonas**

A medical term referring to roseomonas. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **Roseomonas Gilardii**

A medical term referring to *roseomonas gilardii*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Roseomonas Mucosa**

A medical term referring to *roseomonas mucosa*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rosiglitazone**

Rosiglitazone is a PPAR-gamma agonist that improves insulin sensitivity in type 2 diabetes; weight gain, oedema, heart-failure worsening, fractures, and cardiovascular risk require careful patient selection.

### **Rosiglitazone Maleate**

A medical term referring to *rosiglitazone maleate*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Ross River Virus**

ross river virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Rostaporfin**

Rostaporfin is an investigational photosensitizing compound studied for photodynamic treatment of cancer or other abnormal tissue.

### **Rosuvastatin Calcium**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called *rosuvastatin calcium*. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Rotation**

A biological or biochemical term involving rotation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Rotavirus Infection**

rotavirus infection is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Rotenone**

Rotenone is a naturally occurring pesticide that inhibits mitochondrial complex I and can be toxic to people and animals after exposure.

### **Rothia Dentocariosa**

A medical term referring to *rothia dentocariosa*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rothia Mucilaginosa**

A medical term referring to *rothia mucilaginosa*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rotifera**

A medical term referring to *rotifera*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Round Ligament**

A round ligament is a cord-like supporting structure, including the uterine ligaments that pass toward the groin and help maintain uterine position.

### **Roxithromycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called *roxithromycin*. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Rubber**

Rubber is an elastic material used in gloves, devices, and equipment; natural-rubber latex can cause irritant or allergic reactions.

### **Rubber Dams**

A medical term referring to *rubber dams*. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### Rubeosis Iridis

Rubeosis iridis is abnormal growth of new blood vessels on the iris, usually from retinal ischemia such as diabetes or vein occlusion, and may cause neovascular glaucoma.

### Rubidium

A medical term referring to rubidium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rubitecan

A medical term referring to rubitecan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rubivirus

rubivirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Rubredoxins

A medical term referring to rubredoxins. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rubricyte Count

rubricyte count is a diagnostic or laboratory method used to evaluate a clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen or body site, method, reference range, and patient context.

### Rubulavirus

rubulavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Rumen

The rumen is the largest compartment of a ruminant animal's stomach where microbes ferment plant material before digestion continues.

### Rumination

A biological or biochemical term involving rumination. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Ruminococcus

ruminococcus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Ruminococcus Gnavus

ruminococcus gnavus is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### Rural Health

Rural health concerns health outcomes and care access in rural communities, where distance, workforce shortages, transport, resources, and social conditions may affect services.

### Russell-Siver Syndrome

A clinical condition or finding involving russell-siver syndrome. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Ruthenium

A medical term referring to ruthenium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Rutin

A medical term referring to rutin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Ryanodine

A medical term referring to ryanodine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Red Eye

Redness of the white part of the eye caused by irritation, dryness, allergy, infection, injury, inflammation, or increased surface blood flow.

### RA

Alternate index label; see *Rheumatoid arthritis*.

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**Rapid Eye Movement Sleep Behavior Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *REM sleep behavior disorder*.

**Rapid Heartbeat**

Alternate index label; see *Tachycardia*.

**Rash, Poison Ivy**

Alternate index label; see *Poison ivy rash*.

**Reading Disability, Specific**

Alternate index label; see *Dyslexia*.

**Rebound Headache**

Alternate index label; see *Medication overuse headaches*.

**Rectal Inflammation**

Alternate index label; see *Proctitis*.

**Rectal Itching**

Alternate index label; see *Anal itching*.

**Rectal Ulcer**

Alternate index label; see *Solitary rectal ulcer syndrome*.

**Recurrent Oral Ulcers**

Alternate index label; see *Canker sore*.

**Recurrent Prostate Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Prostate cancer recurrence*.

**Reflux, Bile**

Alternate index label; see *Bile reflux*.

**Reflux, Vesicoureteral**

Alternate index label; see *Vesicoureteral reflux*.

**Regurgitation, Aortic Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Aortic valve regurgitation*.

**Regurgitation, Mitral Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Mitral valve regurgitation*.

**Renal Artery Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Renal artery stenosis*.

**Renal Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Kidney cancer*.

**Renal Lithiasis**

Alternate index label; see *Kidney stones*.

**Renal Vascular Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Renal artery stenosis*.

**Retinopathy, Diabetic**

Alternate index label; see *Diabetic retinopathy*.

**Rhinitis, Allergic**

Alternate index label; see *Hay fever*.

**Rhinitis, Nonallergic**

Alternate index label; see *Nonallergic rhinitis*.

**Rhinitis, Vasomotor**

Alternate index label; see *Nonallergic rhinitis*.

**Ringling In The Ear**

Alternate index label; see *Tinnitus*.

**Ringworm Of The Foot**

Alternate index label; see *Athlete's foot*.

**Road Rage**

Alternate index label; see *Intermittent explosive disorder*.

**Round Back**

Alternate index label; see *Kyphosis*.

**Runner's Knee**

Alternate index label; see *Patellofemoral pain syndrome*.

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### **Radial Head Fracture - Aftercare**

Radial head fracture - aftercare examines radial head fracture - aftercare; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radial Nerve Dysfunction**

Radial nerve dysfunction examines radial nerve dysfunction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radiation Therapy - Questions To Ask Your Doctor**

Radiation therapy - questions to ask your doctor examines radiation therapy - questions to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radiation Therapy - Skin Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to radiation therapy - skin care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radical Prostatectomy - Discharge**

Radical prostatectomy - discharge examines radical prostatectomy - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radioactive Iodine Uptake**

Radioactive iodine uptake examines radioactive iodine uptake; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radiofrequency Ablation For Chronic Pain**

A clinical condition or finding involving radiofrequency ablation for chronic pain. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Radioiodine Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to radioiodine therapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Radionuclide Cisternogram**

Radionuclide cisternogram examines radionuclide cisternogram; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Radionuclide Cystogram**

Radionuclide cystogram examines radionuclide cystogram; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Rapid Shallow Breathing**

Rapid shallow breathing is an increased breathing rate with small tidal volumes and may signal lung disease, pain, metabolic illness, fatigue, or respiratory failure.

### **Rash - Child Under 2 Years**

A rash in a child under 2 can result from infection, allergy, heat, irritation, or inflammation; breathing difficulty, lethargy, fever, blistering, or rapid spread needs urgent care.

### **RBC Count**

RBC count examines rbc count; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **RBC Indices**

RBC indices examines rbc indices; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **RBC Nuclear Scan**

RBC nuclear scan examines rbc nuclear scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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## **RBC Urine Test**

RBC urine test examines rbc urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Reactive Attachment Disorder Of Infancy Or Early Childhood**

Reactive attachment disorder of infancy or early childhood examines reactive attachment disorder of infancy or early childhood; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Recognizing Medical Emergencies**

Recognizing a medical emergency includes identifying severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, stroke signs, major bleeding, seizure, collapse, poisoning, or altered consciousness and calling emergency services.

## **Recognizing Teen Depression**

A biological or biochemical term involving recognizing teen depression. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## **Recombinant Zoster (Shingles) Vaccine, RZV - What You Need To Know**

A biological or biochemical term involving recombinant zoster (shingles) vaccine, rzv - what you need to know. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

## **Recovering After Stroke**

Stroke recovery uses rehabilitation for movement, speech, swallowing, thinking, mood, and daily activities while preventing recurrent stroke and managing complications.

## **Rectal Biopsy**

Rectal biopsy examines rectal biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Rectal Culture**

Rectal culture examines rectal culture; interpretation

depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Rectal Prolapse Repair**

Rectal prolapse repair examines rectal prolapse repair; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Red Birthmarks**

Red birthmarks are vascular skin marks present at or soon after birth, ranging from harmless capillary marks to lesions requiring monitoring or specialist treatment.

## **Refractive Corneal Surgery - Discharge**

Refractive corneal surgery - discharge examines refractive corneal surgery - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Refractive Corneal Surgery - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Refractive corneal surgery - what to ask your doctor examines refractive corneal surgery - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Refrigerant Poisoning**

Refrigerant poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to refrigerant poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Relaxation Techniques For Stress**

Relaxation techniques for stress addresses care related to relaxation techniques for stress, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Remembering Tips**

Memory-support strategies include repetition, written reminders, routines, adequate sleep, organization, attention to one task, and evaluation of medical



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or medication causes of decline.

### **Renal And Urological Diseases**

A clinical finding or condition involving renal And Urological Diseases; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Renal Arteriography**

Renal arteriography uses contrast X-rays to visualize kidney arteries and may identify narrowing, bleeding, aneurysm, or vascular anatomy during an intervention.

### **Renal Papillary Necrosis**

Renal papillary necrosis is death of the kidney papillae from ischemia, infection, obstruction, diabetes, sickle-cell disease, or analgesic injury and may cause blood or obstruction.

### **Renal Pelvis Or Ureter Cancer**

A neoplastic condition involving renal Pelvis Or Ureter Cancer; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Renal Perfusion Scintiscan**

Renal perfusion scintiscan examines renal perfusion scintiscan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Renal Vein Thrombosis**

Renal vein thrombosis is a clot in a kidney vein that can cause flank pain, blood or protein in urine, kidney dysfunction, swelling, or pulmonary embolism.

### **Renal Venogram**

Renal venogram examines renal venogram; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Renin Blood Test**

Renin blood test examines renin blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Repair Of Webbed Fingers Or Toes**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to repair of webbed fingers or toes; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Replantation Of Digits**

A biological or biochemical term involving replantation of digits. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Reportable Diseases**

A clinical finding or condition involving reportable Diseases; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Resources**

Resources addresses care related to resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Respiratory**

Respiratory means relating to breathing, the airways, lungs, gas exchange, or the organs and muscles that move air.

### **Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV) Preventive Antibody - What You Need To Know**

An RSV preventive antibody provides temporary passive protection against severe respiratory syncytial virus disease for eligible infants or high-risk people; it is not a vaccine or treatment for established infection.

### **Respiratory Viruses And Face Masks**

Respiratory viruses and face masks addresses care related to respiratory viruses and face masks, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Responsible Drinking**

Responsible drinking addresses care related to responsible drinking, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss

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with a clinician.

### **Retrograde Cystography**

Retrograde cystography is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Retroperitoneal Inflammation**

Retroperitoneal inflammation is inflammatory disease in the space behind the peritoneum, caused by infection, pancreatitis, urinary disease, trauma, medicines, or fibrosis.

### **Retrosternal Thyroid Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to retrosternal thyroid surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Retroversion Of The Uterus**

A biological or biochemical term involving retroversion of the uterus. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Returning To Sports After A Back Injury**

Returning to sports after a back injury addresses care related to returning to sports after a back injury, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Returning To Work After Cancer: Know Your Rights**

Returning to work after cancer: know your rights addresses care related to returning to work after cancer: know your rights, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Reverse Total Shoulder Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to reverse total shoulder replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Reverse Total Shoulder Replacement - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to reverse total shoulder replacement - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Reye Syndrome - Resources**

Reye syndrome - resources addresses care related to reye syndrome - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Rheumatoid Factor (RF)**

Rheumatoid factor (RF) examines rheumatoid factor (rf); interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Rheumatoid Lung Disease**

A clinical condition involving rheumatoid Lung Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Rheumatoid Pneumoconiosis**

A clinical finding or condition involving rheumatoid Pneumoconiosis; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Rhubarb Leaves Poisoning**

Rhubarb leaves poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to rhubarb leaves poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Rib Fracture - Aftercare**

Rib fracture - aftercare examines rib fracture - aftercare; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Ribcage Pain**

Ribcage pain addresses care related to ribcage pain, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

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## **Right Heart Ventricular Angiography**

Right heart ventricular angiography examines right heart ventricular angiography; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Risks Of Hip And Knee Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to risks of hip and knee replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Risks Of Tobacco**

Tobacco use increases risks of cancer, heart and blood-vessel disease, stroke, lung disease, pregnancy complications, addiction, and harm from second-hand smoke.

## **Risks Of Underage Drinking**

Alcohol use by minors can impair brain development, judgment, learning, safety, and mental health and increases risks of injury, dependence, and unsafe sexual or substance-related behavior.

## **Rotator Cuff - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to rotator cuff - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Rotator Cuff Exercises**

Rotator cuff exercises addresses care related to rotator cuff exercises, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Rotator Cuff Problems**

Rotator cuff problems include tendinopathy, bursitis, and tears that cause shoulder pain, weakness, painful motion, and difficulty with overhead activity.

## **Rotator Cuff Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to rotator cuff repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific

intervention and patient.

## **Rotavirus Antigen Test**

Rotavirus antigen test examines rotavirus antigen test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Rotavirus Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called rotavirus vaccine - what you need to know. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **RPR Test**

RPR test examines rpr test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **RSV (Respiratory Syncytial Virus) Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called rsv (respiratory syncytial virus) vaccine - what you need to know. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

## **RSV Antibody Test**

RSV antibody test examines rsv antibody test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Rubber Cement Poisoning**

Rubber cement poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to rubber cement poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Ruptured Eardrum**

A ruptured eardrum is a tear in the tympanic membrane caused by infection, pressure, trauma, or foreign objects and may cause pain, drainage, hearing loss, or dizziness.

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### **RA (Rheumatoid Arthritis)**

Alternate index label for Rheumatoid Arthritis.

### **Rape (Sexual Assault)**

Alternate index label for Sexual Assault.

### **Rash Heat (Heat Rash)**

Alternate index label for Heat Rash.

### **Raynauds Phenomenon (Raynaud's Phenomenon)**

Alternate index label for Raynaud's Phenomenon.

### **Raynauds Syndrome (Raynaud's Phenomenon)**

Alternate index label for Raynaud's Phenomenon.

### **Reasons You Are Tired After Surgery (7 Reasons You Are Tired After Surgery)**

Alternate index label for 7 Reasons You are Tired after Surgery.

### **Rectal Bleeding (Blood In The Stool (Rectal Bleeding))**

Alternate index label for Blood in the Stool (Rectal Bleeding).

### **Renal Failure (Kidney Failure)**

Alternate index label for Kidney Failure.

### **Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs)**

Alternate index label for RMDs.

### **Resistance Antibiotic (Antibiotic Resistance)**

Alternate index label for Antibiotic Resistance.

### **Respiratory Syncytial Virus Contagious (Is Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV) Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV) Contagious.

### **Restless Leg Syndrome**

Restless legs syndrome causes an urge to move the legs with uncomfortable sensations that worsen at rest and in the evening and improve temporarily with movement. Iron deficiency, kidney disease, medicines, pregnancy, and genetics may contribute.

#### **Synonyms:**

Legs Restless (Restless Leg Syndrome) Syndrome

Restless Legs (Restless Leg Syndrome)

### **Reye Johnson Syndrome (Reye Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Reye Syndrome.

### **Rheumatoid Arthritis Cause Gastrointestinal Issues**

Rheumatoid arthritis can affect the gastrointestinal system indirectly through inflammation, associated autoimmune disease, reduced mobility, or medicines such as nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs. Abdominal pain, bleeding, persistent diarrhea, or weight loss needs evaluation rather than attribution to arthritis alone.

### **Rheumatoid Arthritis Inflammation Of The Brain**

Direct brain inflammation is uncommon in rheumatoid arthritis, but vasculitis, medication effects, infection, stroke risk, or another autoimmune process can cause neurologic symptoms. New confusion, seizure, weakness, severe headache, or vision change requires urgent assessment.

### **Rigid And Flexible Sigmoidoscopy**

A sigmoidoscopy examines the rectum and lower colon with a flexible or rigid instrument. It can evaluate bleeding, pain, altered bowel habits, inflammation, polyps, or tumors; preparation, reach, comfort, and biopsy capability differ by technique.

### **Ring Schatzki (Schatzki Ring)**

Alternate index label for Schatzki Ring.

### **Ringings In The Ears (Tinnitus (Ringings**

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### **In The Ears))**

Alternate index label for Tinnitus (Ringing in the Ears).

### **RMDs (Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs))**

Alternate index label for Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs).

### **RMSF (Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever (RMSF))**

Alternate index label for Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever (RMSF).

### **Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever (RMSF)**

Alternate index label for RMSF.

### **Roseola Contagious (Is Roseola Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Roseola Contagious.

### **RSD (Reflex Sympathetic Dystrophy Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Reflex Sympathetic Dystrophy Syndrome.

### **RSI (Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs))**

Alternate index label for Repetitive Motion Disorders (RMDs).

### **RSV (Respiratory Syncytial Virus)**

Alternate index label for Respiratory Syncytial Virus.

### **Ruba Miliaria (Heat Rash)**

Alternate index label for Heat Rash.

### **Rubeola (Measles (Rubeola))**

Alternate index label for Measles (Rubeola).

### **Ruptured Perforated Eardrum**

A perforated eardrum is a tear in the tympanic membrane from infection, pressure change, trauma,

or an inserted object. Pain, drainage, hearing loss, or ringing may occur; keeping the ear dry and avoiding unprescribed drops helps while healing or repair is assessed.

### **R (Symbol)**

R is a symbol whose meaning depends on context, including right side, radius, resistance, or a statistical correlation coefficient.

### **R/O**

R/O is an abbreviation for rule out, indicating that a condition is being considered but has not been confirmed; clear documentation should state the actual diagnostic question.

### **Race**

Race is a social classification that can influence lived experience and health through genetics in limited contexts, discrimination, environment, and access to care; it is not a precise proxy for biology.

### **Radial**

Radial means relating to the radius bone or the thumb side of the forearm, hand, or a structure arranged like radii from a center.

### **Radiomimetic**

Radiomimetic describes a chemical or treatment that produces cellular or DNA damage resembling the effects of ionizing radiation.

### **Raised Hemidiaphragm**

A raised hemidiaphragm is elevation of one side of the diaphragm, caused by abdominal pressure, lung volume loss, phrenic-nerve dysfunction, or diaphragmatic disease.

### **Ramus**

A ramus is a branch-like extension of a bone, nerve, artery, or other structure, such as the mandibular ramus.

### **Random**

Random means determined by chance rather than a

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predictable pattern; randomization in research helps balance known and unknown confounding factors.

### **RANTES**

RANTES, now called CCL5, is a chemokine that attracts immune cells and participates in inflammation, antiviral defense, and immune signaling.

### **Rapid Plasma Reagin Test**

Rapid plasma reagin test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Raw Egg**

Raw eggs may contain Salmonella and are safest when properly refrigerated, handled hygienically, and cooked unless pasteurized products are used.

### **RBC**

RBC is the abbreviation for red blood cell, the cell that transports oxygen with hemoglobin and carries carbon dioxide back toward the lungs.

### **RDS (Respiratory Distress Syndrome)**

A clinical condition involving rDS (Respiratory Distress Syndrome); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Reabsorption**

A clinical condition or finding involving reabsorption. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Rebound Effect**

A medical term referring to rebound effect. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Recalcitrant**

A medical term referring to recalcitrant. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Recent Memory**

Recent memory is the ability to recall information

or events from the near past and can be impaired by aging, delirium, brain disease, depression, or medicines.

### **Recession Of Medial Rectus Muscle**

Recession of Medial Rectus Muscle refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Recommended Daily Allowance**

The Recommended Dietary Allowance is the average daily nutrient intake sufficient for nearly all healthy people in a specified age and sex group.

### **Rectal (Adjective)**

Rectal means relating to the rectum, the final part of the large intestine before the anal canal.

### **Rectouterine Pouch**

The rectouterine pouch, or pouch of Douglas, is the peritoneal recess between the uterus and rectum where fluid or disease may collect.

### **Recur**

To recur means to return or happen again, as symptoms, disease, infection, or a tumor after a period of improvement or treatment.

### **Regional Enteritis**

A biological or biochemical term involving regional enteritis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Rehab**

A medical term referring to rehab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Rehydration**

A biological or biochemical term involving rehydration. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Reinnervation**

A biological or biochemical term involving rein-



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nervation. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Remedy**

A medical term referring to remedy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Renal Calculi**

Renal calculi are kidney stones formed from crystallized minerals in urine and may cause colicky flank pain, blood in urine, obstruction, or infection.

### **Renal Stone**

A renal stone is a solid crystal aggregate formed in the kidney that can pass through the urinary tract or obstruct urine flow.

### **Rep**

Rep is an abbreviation whose meaning depends on context, including repetition in exercise or representative in a professional role.

### **Reproductive Cells**

Reproductive cells refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Reproductive Organs, Female**

Female reproductive organs include the ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, cervix, vagina, and external genitalia, which support hormones, ovulation, menstruation, pregnancy, and birth.

### **Research, Controlled**

Controlled research compares an intervention or exposure with a specified control condition to estimate effects while reducing alternative explanations.

### **Reservoir Of Infection**

A reservoir of infection is a person, animal, environment, or material in which an infectious organism normally lives and from which transmission can occur.

### **Resident**

A resident is a physician or other trainee receiving supervised specialty education after initial professional qualification; the term can also mean a person living in a place.

### **Residual**

Residual means remaining after a process, treatment, measurement, or event, such as residual urine, disease, risk, or volume.

### **Respiratory Distress Syndrome (RDS)**

A clinical condition involving respiratory Distress Syndrome (RDS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Respiratory Insufficiency**

Respiratory insufficiency is inadequate gas exchange or ventilatory function causing low oxygen, high carbon dioxide, or both; causes include lung, airway, neuromuscular, and central respiratory disorders.

### **Rest**

Rest is reduced physical or mental activity used to recover, though excessive inactivity can impair strength and function in some conditions.

### **Resting Phase**

The resting phase is a period of relative inactivity, such as G0 in the cell cycle or a physiologic interval between active events.

### **Restless Anal Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving restless Anal Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Restless Legs**

Restless-legs syndrome causes an urge to move the legs with uncomfortable sensations, beginning or worsening at rest and in the evening and improving temporarily with movement; iron deficiency and medicines may contribute.

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## Retromingent

Retromingent describes urination directed backward, a term historically applied to unusual urinary stream direction or anatomy.

## Reuptake

Reuptake is transport of a released neurotransmitter or other molecule back into the cell that released it or into nearby cells, limiting its signal.

## RF

RF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including rheumatoid factor, radiofrequency, or risk factor; the complete term should be stated.

## Rib Cage

The rib cage consists of ribs, sternum, thoracic vertebrae, muscles, and connective tissues that protect chest organs and assist breathing.

## Ribonucleic Acid (RNA)

A biological substance or process involving ribonucleic Acid (RNA); its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

## Ribonucleoprotein (RNP)

A biomedical term referring to ribonucleoprotein (rnp); its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

## Ringworm (Tinea)

Ringworm is a superficial dermatophyte fungal infection of skin, scalp, or nails that produces scaly annular lesions or hair loss; treatment depends on the site and may require topical or oral antifungals.

## RIRS (Retrograde Intrarenal Surgery)

RIRS is a minimally invasive procedure using a flexible scope passed through the urinary tract to inspect and fragment or remove kidney stones.

## RLL

RLL is the abbreviation for right lower lobe, usually

referring to the lower lobe of the right lung.

## RLQ

RLQ is the abbreviation for right lower quadrant of the abdomen, containing structures including the appendix, cecum, and right adnexa.

## RML

RML is the abbreviation for right middle lobe, the middle lobe of the right lung.

## Robust

Robust means strong, resilient, or relatively insensitive to variation; in research, a robust result remains stable under reasonable analytic changes.

## Rock (Drug)

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to rock (drug); its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Rod

A rod is a long cylindrical structure; in the retina, a rod photoreceptor supports dim-light and peripheral vision.

## Roentgenology

Roentgenology is the historical term for the use and study of X-rays in medical diagnosis and imaging.

## Round

Round means circular or approximately spherical; in anatomy or pathology it describes shape and must be interpreted with the structure being described.

## RP

RP is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly retinitis pigmentosa, an inherited retinal degeneration causing night blindness and progressive visual-field loss.

## RT

RT is a context-dependent abbreviation, including radiation therapy, respiratory therapist, or right;

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the full term should be specified.

### **RT-PCR**

RT-PCR converts RNA to complementary DNA and amplifies target sequences, allowing detection or measurement of RNA viruses, genes, and transcripts.

### **RUL**

RUL is the abbreviation for right upper lobe, usually referring to the upper lobe of the right lung.

### **Rule Out**

Rule out means evaluate a possibility and determine whether it is present; it does not mean the condition has already been excluded.

### **Runny Nose**

Runny nose refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **RUQ**

RUQ is the abbreviation for right upper quadrant of the abdomen, containing the liver, gallbladder, duodenum, and portions of bowel and kidney.

### **RV (Rotavirus)**

Rotavirus is a highly contagious virus causing vomiting and watery diarrhea, especially in infants and young children; vaccination substantially reduces severe disease.

### **RVF**

RVF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including Rift Valley fever, an infection transmitted by mosquitoes or infected animals, or right ventricular failure.

### **Ruptured Eardrum (Perforated Eardrum)**

A hole or tear in the eardrum that may cause pain, drainage, hearing loss, or ringing and can result from infection, injury, or pressure changes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Eardrum, Ruptured Perforated Eardrum

### **Round Ligament Pain**

Sharp or aching pain in the lower abdomen or groin caused by stretching of the round ligaments as the uterus enlarges during pregnancy. Persistent, severe, or bleeding-associated pain requires medical evaluation.

### **Reticular**

Net-like or arranged in a network pattern, describing the appearance or distribution of a skin lesion, rash, or vascular pattern.

### **Renin-Angiotensin System**

A hormone and enzyme system that regulates blood pressure, fluid balance, and vascular tone. Renin initiates formation of angiotensin II, which promotes vasoconstriction and aldosterone release; excessive activation contributes to hypertension and heart failure.

### **Ring Vaccination**

A public-health strategy in which close contacts and contacts of contacts around an identified case are vaccinated to create a protective ring and limit transmission.

### **Reduction Mammoplasty**

Surgery that removes breast tissue, fat, and excess skin to reduce breast size and relieve symptoms such as neck, shoulder, or back discomfort; it may also reshape the breasts.

### **Rheumatoid Synovitis**

Chronic autoimmune inflammation of synovial tissue in rheumatoid arthritis, producing pain, swelling, pannus formation, cartilage damage, and progressive joint destruction.

### **Rare Disease**

A condition affecting relatively few people in a defined population; many rare diseases are genetic, require specialized diagnosis, and may have limited evidence or treatment options.

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## S

### 16S Ribosomal RNA Sequencing

Molecular identification of bacteria and archaea using conserved and variable regions of the 16S ribosomal RNA gene. It is useful for difficult-to-culture organisms but may not distinguish closely related species or provide susceptibility data.

### SAD

Seasonal affective disorder, a recurring mood disorder linked to seasonal changes and reduced daylight.

#### Synonyms:

Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD)

### Sabin Vaccine

The oral polio vaccine containing live attenuated poliovirus strains.

### Saccharomyces

A genus of yeasts, including *S. cerevisiae*; some species are used industrially and can rarely cause opportunistic infection.

### Sacral Nerves

The spinal nerves arising from the sacral spinal cord and supplying the pelvis, pelvic floor, bladder, bowel, and lower limbs.

### Sacroileitis

A misspelling or variant of sacroiliitis, inflammation of a sacroiliac joint.

### Sadism

Sexual arousal or gratification from inflicting pain, humiliation, or suffering; clinical significance depends on distress, impairment, or nonconsent.

### Safe Period

A fertility-awareness term for days believed to have a lower chance of conception; cycle variation makes it unreliable as sole contraception.

### Safety Of Drugs

The assessment and management of medicine benefits, risks, interactions, contraindications, monitoring, and safe use.

### Salaam Attacks

Brief repeated flexor spasms or head drops in infants, historically associated with infantile spasms.

### Salicylic Acid

A keratolytic and anti-inflammatory compound used topically for acne, psoriasis, warts, and other hyperkeratotic disorders.

### Salivary Glands

Exocrine glands that produce saliva, including the parotid, submandibular, and sublingual glands.

### Salk Vaccine

The inactivated poliovirus vaccine administered by injection.

### Salmonella Infections

Infections caused by *Salmonella* bacteria, ranging from gastroenteritis to enteric fever or invasive bloodstream disease.

### Salmon Patches

Flat pink or red capillary birthmarks, commonly on the eyelids, forehead, or nape; many fade during

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infancy.

### **Salpingo-**

A combining form relating to a fallopian tube.

### **Salpingo-OöPhorectomy**

Surgical removal of a fallopian tube and ovary, also called salpingo-oophorectomy.

### **Salt**

An ionic chemical compound; dietary sodium chloride is essential in small amounts but excess intake can increase blood pressure.

### **Sandfly Fever**

An acute viral illness transmitted by phlebotomine sandflies, causing fever, headache, muscle pain, and sometimes rash.

### **Sanguineous**

Containing or consisting of blood.

### **Saphenous**

Relating to the superficial veins of the lower limb, especially the great or small saphenous vein.

### **Saprophyte**

An organism that obtains nutrients from dead organic material; some saprophytic organisms can become opportunistic pathogens.

### **Sarco-**

A combining form meaning flesh or soft tissue.

### **Sarcoptes**

The mite genus containing *Sarcoptes scabiei*, the cause of scabies.

### **SARS**

Severe acute respiratory syndrome, a viral respiratory illness caused by SARS-CoV.

### **Scab**

A crust of dried blood, serum, pus, or tissue fluid

over a healing skin injury.

### **Scabicide**

A medicine that kills scabies mites.

### **Scalded-Skin Syndrome**

Staphylococcal scalded-skin syndrome, a toxin-mediated superficial epidermal separation causing tender erythema and peeling, especially in children.

### **Scalds**

Burns caused by hot liquids or steam.

### **Scalp**

The skin and underlying tissues covering the skull.

### **Scanning Speech**

A slow, irregularly paced speech pattern with abnormal emphasis, classically associated with cerebellar or multiple-sclerosis disease.

### **Scanning Techniques**

Imaging or measurement methods that systematically examine a body region, organ, or sample.

### **Scar**

Fibrous tissue formed during healing after injury, inflammation, or surgery.

### **Scheuermann's Disease**

A juvenile spinal growth disorder causing wedging of vertebral bodies and structural kyphosis.

### **Schistomicide**

A substance that kills *Schistosoma* parasites.

### **Schizo-**

A combining form relating to splitting or schizophrenia.

### **Schizogony**

A form of asexual reproduction in which one protozoan cell divides into many daughter cells.



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### **Schwann Cell**

A peripheral glial cell that forms myelin or supports axons.

### **Scirrhus**

A hard, fibrous form of carcinoma, historically used especially for breast or gastric cancer.

### **Scorbutic**

Relating to scurvy or vitamin C deficiency.

### **Scrivener's Palsy**

An older term for task-specific hand dystonia or cramp occurring during writing.

### **Scrombotoxin Poisoning**

A misspelled or nonstandard form referring to scombrotoxin poisoning, caused by histamine in improperly stored fish.

### **Scrum-Pox**

A nonstandard or historical term whose intended clinical meaning is unclear and should be verified from its source.

### **Scurf**

Fine flakes or scales shed from the skin, especially the scalp.

### **Sea-Sickness**

Motion sickness occurring during travel at sea.

### **Seasonal Affective Disorder Syndrome**

Seasonal affective disorder, a recurring mood disorder with episodes linked to a particular season.

### **Sebaceous Cyst**

A common but imprecise term for an epidermoid cyst, a keratin-filled cyst beneath the skin.

### **Sebaceous Glands**

Skin glands that secrete sebum, usually into hair follicles.

### **Sebum**

An oily secretion produced by sebaceous glands that lubricates and protects skin and hair.

### **Secondary Sexual Characteristics**

Physical changes of puberty that distinguish mature males and females but are not directly part of the reproductive organs.

### **Sedimentation Rate**

The erythrocyte sedimentation rate, a nonspecific blood test that may increase with inflammation, infection, anemia, or other conditions.

### **Sedatives**

Medicines or substances that reduce central nervous system activity and produce calmness or sleepiness.

### **Selective Serotonin-Reuptake Inhibitors (SSRIs)**

Antidepressants that increase serotonin signaling by inhibiting its reuptake into nerve terminals.

### **Selegiline**

A monoamine-oxidase-B inhibitor used in selected treatment of Parkinson disease and sometimes depression.

### **Selenium Sulphide**

A topical antifungal and antiseborrheic medicine used for dandruff and seborrheic dermatitis.

### **Self-Poisoning**

Intentional ingestion or exposure to a potentially harmful substance, often requiring urgent medical and mental-health assessment.

### **Sella Turcica**

A saddle-shaped depression in the sphenoid bone containing the pituitary gland.

### **Semilunar Cartilages**

The crescent-shaped fibrocartilages of the knee, more commonly called menisci.

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### **Seminiferous Tubules**

Tightly coiled testicular tubules in which sperm are produced.

### **Seminoma**

A malignant germ-cell tumor of the testis, usually sensitive to radiotherapy and chemotherapy.

### **Senile Dementia**

An outdated term formerly used for dementia in older adults; current diagnosis specifies the cause.

### **Senility**

An outdated, imprecise term for age-related decline; modern assessment identifies specific medical, cognitive, or functional causes.

### **Senna**

A plant-derived stimulant laxative containing sennosides.

### **Sensation**

Perception of stimuli such as touch, pain, temperature, sound, or position.

### **Sensitisation**

The process by which repeated exposure increases an immune, neural, or behavioral response.

### **Sensitivity**

The proportion of people with a condition who have a positive test result; it also means responsiveness to a stimulus.

### **Sensory**

Relating to sensation or sensory nerves and pathways.

### **Sensory Cortex**

Cerebral cortex that receives and interprets sensory information, especially the postcentral gyrus for body sensation.

### **Sensory Deprivation**

Marked reduction of normal sensory input, which can affect mood, cognition, and perception.

### **Sepsis**

Life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated response to infection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Septicemia (Sepsis)

### **Septal Defect**

An abnormal opening between chambers of the heart or between other bodily compartments.

### **Septicaemia**

An older term for bloodstream infection, often used to describe bacteremia with systemic illness.

### **Septic Arthritis**

Infection of a joint, usually bacterial, causing acute pain, swelling, restricted movement, and systemic illness.

#### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis Infectious (Septic Arthritis)

### **Septic Shock**

A life-threatening form of circulatory failure caused by sepsis, with persistent hypotension or tissue hypoperfusion despite fluid treatment.

### **Septum**

A wall or partition separating two spaces or tissues.

### **Sequelae**

Persistent consequences or complications that remain after an illness or injury.

### **Sequestrum**

A piece of dead bone or tissue separated from living tissue, commonly occurring in chronic osteomyelitis.

### **Seroconversion**

Development of detectable antibodies in blood after infection, vaccination, or another immune stimulus.

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## Serotype

A distinct variation of a microorganism or antigen defined by its immune reactivity.

## Serous

Thin, watery, and usually clear; serous fluid resembles serum.

## Serous Membranes

Smooth membranes lining closed body cavities and covering organs, such as pleura, pericardium, and peritoneum.

## Serum

The liquid portion of blood remaining after clotting, lacking fibrinogen and most clotting factors.

## Serum Sickness

An immune-complex reaction after exposure to a foreign protein or some medicines, causing fever, rash, joint pain, and sometimes organ involvement.

## Serum Therapy

Treatment using serum or serum-derived antibodies, historically including antitoxins and immunoglobulin preparations.

## Sesamoid Bones

Small bones embedded in tendons, such as the patella and bones beneath the big toe.

## Sessile

Attached by a broad base rather than a stalk, as in a sessile polyp.

## Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS)

A severe viral respiratory illness caused by SARS-CoV.

### Synonyms:

Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS))

## Sex Change

A nontechnical term for gender transition or medical

gender-affirming care; respectful, current terminology should be used.

## Sex Chromosomes

The X and Y chromosomes, which contribute to sex development and carry many other genes.

## Sex Education

Education about anatomy, relationships, consent, contraception, sexually transmitted infections, and sexual health.

## Sex Hormones

Hormones involved in reproductive development and function, including estrogens, progesterone, and androgens.

## Sex-Linked Inheritance

Inheritance of a trait caused by a gene on a sex chromosome, commonly the X chromosome.

## Sex Therapy

Structured psychological or behavioral therapy for sexual concerns or dysfunction.

## Sexual Abuse

Nonconsensual sexual contact, exploitation, or behavior; it is a safeguarding and health emergency when immediate danger or injury exists.

## Sexual Deviation

An obsolete and stigmatizing term for atypical sexual interests; current assessment focuses on consent, distress, impairment, and harm.

## Sexual Dysfunction

Persistent difficulty with sexual desire, arousal, orgasm, or pain that causes distress or impairment.

## Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs)

Infections transmitted mainly through sexual contact, including chlamydia, gonorrhea, syphilis, HIV, and HPV.

### Synonyms:

STDs

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### Shaken Impact Syndrome

A term for abusive head trauma involving shaking with or without impact, especially in infants.

### Shellfish Poisoning

Illness caused by toxins accumulated in shellfish, producing gastrointestinal, neurologic, or paralytic symptoms.

### Shigella

A genus of bacteria causing shigellosis, an acute diarrheal illness that may include fever and bloody stools.

### Shingles

Herpes zoster, reactivation of varicella-zoster virus in sensory nerves causing a painful unilateral vesicular rash.

### Shin Splints

Pain along the inner border of the shin, often referring to medial tibial stress syndrome from repetitive loading.

#### Synonyms:

Medial Tibial Stress Syndrome

### Shock

A life-threatening state of circulatory failure in which inadequate tissue perfusion and oxygen delivery cause cellular and organ dysfunction. Major mechanisms are hypovolaemia, cardiac pump failure, distributive vasodilation, and obstruction to blood flow; features may include hypotension, tachycardia, altered mental status, cold or abnormal skin perfusion, and reduced urine output.

### Shock Lung

An older term for acute respiratory distress syndrome.

### Shock Therapy

An imprecise term that may refer to electroconvulsive therapy or outdated shock treatments; the specific intervention should be named.

### Short-Sight

Myopia, a refractive error in which distant objects are focused in front of the retina.

### Short Stature

Height substantially below the expected range for age and sex, requiring assessment of growth pattern and cause.

### Shoulder

The region and joint connecting the upper limb to the trunk.

### Shunt

A passage that diverts blood, cerebrospinal fluid, urine, or another fluid from one channel to another.

### Sialagogues

Substances or medicines that stimulate saliva production.

### Sialorrhoea

Excessive drooling or salivation.

### Sibling

A person's brother or sister; family history from siblings can inform genetic and disease risk assessment.

### Sickle-Cell Anaemia

A hereditary hemoglobin disorder in which HbS polymerization causes chronic hemolytic anemia and episodic vaso-occlusive pain.

### Sickness

A general term for illness or nausea; clinical assessment should identify the specific symptom or disease.

### Side-Effects

Unintended effects of a medicine or treatment, which may be mild, serious, predictable, or idiosyncratic.

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## Siderosis

Accumulation of iron in tissues, or lung disease caused by inhalation of iron-containing dust.

## SIDS

Sudden infant death syndrome, the sudden unexplained death of an infant younger than one year after thorough investigation.

## Sight

The ability to see, involving the eyes and visual nervous system.

## Sildenafil Citrate

The citrate salt of sildenafil, a phosphodiesterase-5 inhibitor used for erectile dysfunction and pulmonary arterial hypertension.

## Silicones

Synthetic polymers used in medical devices, implants, dressings, and other products; adverse effects depend on formulation and site.

## Silicosis

A fibrotic lung disease caused by inhalation of respirable crystalline silica dust.

## Simmonds' Disease

An older term for hypopituitarism, especially pituitary failure causing wasting and endocrine deficiency.

## Simvastatin

A statin medicine that lowers LDL cholesterol by inhibiting HMG-CoA reductase.

## Singer's Nodule

A vocal-fold nodule caused by chronic voice overuse, producing persistent hoarseness.

## Sinoatrial Node

The heart's natural pacemaker in the right atrium that normally initiates each heartbeat.

## Sinus

A cavity, channel, or tract; in clinical use it commonly refers to a paranasal sinus or an abnormal draining tract.

## Sinusitis

Inflammation of the paranasal sinuses, usually causing facial pressure, nasal obstruction, discharge, or reduced smell.

## Sinusoid

A small, highly permeable blood vessel, especially in the liver, spleen, and bone marrow.

## Sinus Tachycardia

A heart rhythm originating in the sinoatrial node with a faster-than-normal rate, often due to exercise, fever, pain, anemia, or stress.

## SI Units

The International System of Units used for standardized measurements, including meter, kilogram, second, mole, and pascal.

## Sjögren's Syndrome

An autoimmune disease causing dry eyes and mouth and sometimes systemic glandular, lung, kidney, nerve, or joint involvement.

### Synonyms:

Sjögren's Disease

## Skeletal Muscle

Striated muscle attached to bones and generally under voluntary control.

## Skeleton

The framework of bones and cartilage supporting the body and protecting organs.

## Skin

The body's outer covering, consisting mainly of epidermis and dermis with appendages such as hair and glands.

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### **Skin Test**

Alternate index label for diagnostic or immunologic skin tests, including prick, patch, and tuberculin testing.

### **Skin, Diseases Of**

Conditions affecting skin, hair, nails, glands, or subcutaneous tissue, including infection, inflammation, neoplasia, and genetic disorders.

### **Skin-Grafting**

Transfer of skin from a donor site to cover a wound or tissue defect.

### **Skull**

The bony framework of the head, protecting the brain and supporting the face.

### **Slapped Cheek Syndrome**

Erythema infectiosum, a parvovirus B19 infection causing a slapped-cheek rash and sometimes joint or hematologic complications.

### **SLE**

Systemic lupus erythematosus, a chronic autoimmune disease that can affect skin, joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, and other organs.

### **Sleep**

A recurring state of reduced awareness and responsiveness with characteristic brain and body physiology.

#### **Synonyms:**

Disorders Sleep (Sleep)

### **Sleep Apnoeas**

Repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep, caused by airway obstruction, impaired respiratory drive, or both.

### **Sleep, Disorders Of**

Conditions that alter sleep quantity, timing, quality, breathing, movement, or behavior.

### **Sleeping Sickness**

African trypanosomiasis, a tsetse-fly-borne infection caused by *Trypanosoma brucei* that can progress to neurologic disease.

### **Slough**

Dead or detached tissue separating from a wound, ulcer, or inflamed surface.

### **Small-Bowel Transplantation**

Surgical replacement of a diseased or nonfunctioning small intestine with donor bowel.

### **Small-Cell Carcinoma**

An aggressive neuroendocrine cancer, most commonly arising in the lung.

### **Smallpox**

A severe contagious disease caused by variola virus; it has been eradicated globally.

### **Smegma**

A collection of shed cells, oils, and moisture around the genital folds, which may promote irritation if hygiene is poor.

### **Smell**

The sense of detecting airborne chemicals through olfactory receptors.

### **Smoke Inhalation**

Injury from breathing smoke, hot gases, or combustion products, potentially causing airway burns, poisoning, and lung injury.

### **Smoking**

Inhalation of smoke from burning tobacco or other substances, associated with addiction, cancer, cardiovascular disease, and lung disease.

### **Smooth Muscle**

Involuntary muscle in the walls of hollow organs, blood vessels, and airways.



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### **Snake-Bite**

A wound from a snake that may cause local injury, envenomation, infection, or systemic toxicity.

### **Snapping Finger**

Trigger finger, painful catching or locking of a finger caused by stenosing inflammation around a flexor tendon.

### **Sneezing**

A forceful reflex expulsion of air through the nose and mouth, often triggered by nasal irritation.

### **Snellen Chart**

A chart of letters or symbols used to measure visual acuity at a specified distance.

### **Snoring**

Noisy breathing during sleep caused by vibration of narrowed upper-airway tissues.

### **Snow Blindness**

Photokeratitis, painful temporary corneal injury from intense ultraviolet exposure, often reflected by snow or ice.

### **Snuffles**

A runny or congested nose; in newborns, persistent snuffles can be a sign of congenital syphilis.

### **Social Medicine**

The study and practice of how social conditions affect health and healthcare.

### **Sodium**

The main extracellular cation, essential for fluid balance, nerve function, and muscle activity.

### **Sodium Aurothiomalate**

An injectable gold compound formerly used to treat rheumatoid arthritis and now rarely used.

### **Sodium Chloride**

The salt sodium chloride; sterile solutions are used

for fluid replacement, irrigation, and drug dilution.

### **Sodium Cromoglycate**

A mast-cell stabilizer used in selected allergy and asthma treatments; also called cromolyn.

### **Sodium Diatrizoate**

An iodinated contrast medium used historically for radiographic imaging.

### **Sodium Hypochlorite**

A chlorine-containing disinfectant and bleach; concentrated exposure can cause corrosive injury.

### **Sodium Valproate**

An anticonvulsant and mood stabilizer; it carries important pregnancy and reproductive risks and requires specialist prescribing.

### **Sodomy**

A legal or historical term for certain sexual acts; it is not a medical diagnosis and should be replaced by precise, nonjudgmental language.

### **Solar Plexus**

A network of autonomic nerves in the upper abdomen, centered around the celiac plexus.

### **Solution**

A homogeneous mixture in which one or more substances are dissolved in a solvent; medical solutions include saline and antiseptics.

### **Solvent Abuse (Misuse)**

Harmful inhalation or ingestion of volatile solvents, which can cause neurologic, cardiac, liver, kidney, or respiratory injury.

### **Somatic**

Relating to the body, especially the body wall and musculoskeletal system, or to physical symptoms.

### **Somatoform Diseases**

An obsolete term for disorders with prominent physical symptoms or health concerns associated with

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psychological distress.

### **Somatostatin**

A hormone that inhibits secretion of growth hormone, insulin, glucagon, and several gastrointestinal hormones.

### **Somatotype**

A descriptive body-build classification; it is not a disease diagnosis.

### **Somnambulism**

Sleepwalking, a parasomnia involving complex behavior during incomplete arousal from sleep.

### **Soporifics**

Medicines or substances that induce sleep or drowsiness.

### **Sore**

Painful or tender; a sore may also mean an open skin or mucosal lesion.

### **Sore Throat**

Pain or irritation in the throat, commonly caused by viral infection but sometimes by streptococcal infection or other disease.

### **Sotalol**

A medicine with beta-blocking and class III antiarrhythmic effects, used for selected cardiac rhythm disorders.

### **Sound**

Mechanical energy transmitted as waves and perceived by hearing; clinical sound assessment includes speech and respiratory or cardiac sounds.

### **Soya**

Soybean and products made from it; soy is a food source and can cause allergy in susceptible people.

### **Space Medicine**

The medical specialty concerned with human health and performance in aviation and space environments.

### **Spanish Fly**

A historical name for cantharidin-containing blister beetles; ingestion is poisonous and it is not a safe aphrodisiac.

### **Spasm**

An involuntary, often painful contraction of a muscle or group of muscles.

### **Spasmodic Torticollis**

Cervical dystonia causing involuntary contractions and abnormal twisting or posture of the neck.

### **Spastic**

Characterized by increased muscle tone and velocity-dependent resistance to stretch.

### **Spatula**

A flat instrument used to spread, mix, examine, or transfer material.

### **Specialist**

A healthcare professional with advanced training in a particular field.

### **Specificity**

The proportion of people without a condition who have a negative test result.

### **Speculum**

An instrument used to hold open a body passage for examination or procedures.

### **Speech Disorders**

Conditions affecting production, fluency, voice, articulation, or motor control of speech.

### **Speech Therapy**

Assessment and treatment of communication, speech, voice, language, and swallowing disorders.

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**Sperm**

Male reproductive cells capable of fertilizing an ovum.

**Spermatic**

Relating to sperm or the structures that produce, transport, or support sperm.

**Spermatic Cord**

A cord-like structure containing the vas deferens, testicular vessels, nerves, and lymphatics.

**Spermatogenesis**

Production and maturation of sperm in the seminiferous tubules.

**Spermatorrhoea**

An obsolete term for involuntary or excessive semen discharge.

**Spermatozoa**

Plural of spermatozoon, mature male reproductive cells.

**Spermatozoon**

A mature male reproductive cell, or sperm cell.

**Spermicide**

A substance that immobilizes or destroys sperm and is used as a contraceptive.

**Sphenoid**

Relating to the sphenoid bone at the base of the skull.

**Sphygmograph**

An instrument that records the arterial pulse waveform.

**Sphygmomanometer**

An instrument for measuring arterial blood pressure.

**Spina Bifida**

A neural-tube defect caused by incomplete closure

of the vertebral arch, ranging from occult defects to open myelomeningocele.

**Spinal Anaesthesia**

Injection of local anesthetic into cerebrospinal fluid in the lumbar spine to produce regional numbness.

**Spinal Column**

The vertebral column, consisting of vertebrae, discs, ligaments, and joints that support and protect the spinal cord.

**Spinal Cord**

The cylindrical nervous tissue within the vertebral canal that carries signals between brain and body and mediates reflexes.

**Spine And Spinal Cord, Diseases And Injuries Of**

Disorders or trauma affecting vertebrae, discs, ligaments, spinal cord, or nerve roots.

**Spiramycin**

A macrolide antibiotic used in selected infections, including some prenatal toxoplasmosis protocols.

**Spirillum**

A spiral-shaped bacterium; *Spirillum minus* can cause rat-bite fever.

**Spirit**

A volatile liquid preparation or alcohol; the meaning depends on the medical, pharmaceutical, or general context.

**Spiritual Pain**

Distress involving meaning, purpose, beliefs, identity, or connection, often addressed in palliative and supportive care.

**Spirochaete**

A slender spiral-shaped bacterium, including *Treponema*, *Borrelia*, and *Leptospira*.

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## **Spirometer**

An instrument that measures lung volumes and airflow.

## **Spirolactone**

An aldosterone antagonist and potassium-sparing diuretic used for heart failure, hypertension, hyperaldosteronism, and other indications.

## **Splanchnic**

Relating to the internal organs, especially abdominal organs and their blood vessels or nerves.

## **Spleen**

A lymphoid organ in the upper-left abdomen. Its red pulp filters blood and removes aged or abnormal blood cells; its white pulp supports immune responses. It also stores platelets and helps clear blood-borne microorganisms.

## **Spleen, Diseases Of**

Disorders affecting splenic structure or function, including splenomegaly, infarction, infection, cysts, abscess, rupture, vascular disease, and hematologic or infiltrative disorders.

## **Splenectomy**

Surgical removal of the spleen, performed for selected traumatic, hematologic, malignant, vascular, or other disorders. It increases the risk of severe infection with encapsulated bacteria and requires preventive planning.

## **Splenomegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of the spleen, usually secondary to infection, liver or portal-venous disease, hemolysis, hematologic malignancy, storage disease, or inflammation. It may cause left-upper-quadrant fullness or pain and increases rupture risk.

## **Splinter Haemorrhages**

Small linear bleeding beneath a nail, caused by trauma, endocarditis, vasculitis, or other conditions.

## **Splints**

Devices that support, immobilize, align, or protect an injured or diseased body part.

## **Spondylitis**

Inflammation of one or more vertebrae or the spine.

## **Spondylolisthesis**

Forward or backward displacement of one vertebra relative to another.

## **Spondylosis**

Degenerative changes of the spine involving vertebrae, discs, and facet joints.

## **Spongiform Encephalopathy**

A fatal or progressive neurodegenerative disorder with sponge-like brain changes, including prion diseases.

## **Sporadic**

Occurring irregularly or as an isolated case rather than in a predictable pattern or family cluster.

## **Spore**

A resistant reproductive or survival structure produced by fungi, bacteria, or some plants.

## **Sporozoa**

An older group name for spore-forming protozoan parasites, including Plasmodium.

## **Sporozoites**

Motile infective forms of certain protozoa, such as the Plasmodium forms injected by mosquitoes.

## **Sports Medicine**

The field concerned with prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and rehabilitation of activity-related injury and performance problems.

## **Spots Before The Eyes**

Visual floaters, flashes, or scotomata perceived in the visual field; sudden onset requires urgent assess-

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ment.

### **Spotted Fever**

A group of tick-borne rickettsial illnesses causing fever, headache, and often a spotted rash.

### **Sprains**

Injuries involving stretching or tearing of ligaments around a joint.

### **Sprue**

A malabsorption syndrome, especially tropical sprue or celiac disease in older terminology.

### **Sputum**

Mucus or other material coughed up from the lower respiratory tract.

### **Squill**

A plant-derived cardiac glycoside source historically used as an expectorant or cardiac medicine; toxicity limits use.

### **Squint**

Strabismus, misalignment of the eyes so they do not point in the same direction.

### **SSRIs**

Selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitors, antidepressants that increase serotonin signaling.

### **Stabs**

Brief, sharp, stabbing pains or injuries; the exact cause depends on site and context.

### **Staghorn Calculus**

A branching kidney stone that fills part or all of the renal pelvis and calyces, often associated with infection.

### **Stammering**

Stuttering, a speech-fluency disorder involving repetitions, prolongations, or blocks.

### **Standard Deviation**

A statistical measure of the spread of observations around their mean.

### **Stannosis**

Pneumoconiosis caused by inhalation of tin oxide dust.

### **Stanozolol**

A synthetic anabolic androgenic steroid with limited medical use and potential liver, lipid, and cardiovascular toxicity.

### **Stapedectomy**

Surgical removal or replacement of the stapes, usually to treat otosclerosis and conductive hearing loss.

### **Stapes**

The smallest auditory ossicle, transmitting vibrations from the incus to the inner ear.

### **Staphylococcus**

A genus of gram-positive cocci that includes *S. aureus* and common skin colonizers and pathogens.

### **Starch**

A plant polysaccharide digested to glucose and an important dietary carbohydrate.

### **Starvation**

Severe prolonged deficiency of food or energy intake causing wasting, metabolic adaptation, and organ dysfunction.

### **Stasis**

Slowing or stopping of normal flow, such as blood, lymph, or intestinal contents.

### **STAT**

A medical instruction meaning immediately or with urgent priority.

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**Status Asthmaticus**

A severe asthma exacerbation that fails to respond adequately to initial treatment and may cause respiratory failure.

**Status Epilepticus**

A prolonged seizure or recurrent seizures without recovery between them, requiring emergency treatment.

**STD(S)**

Abbreviation for sexually transmitted disease(s), now often called sexually transmitted infections.

**Steatoma**

A fatty or sebaceous mass; the term may refer to a lipoma or, in the ear, a cholesteatoma depending on context.

**Steatorrhoea**

Excess fat in stools, causing pale, bulky, greasy, foul-smelling stools and suggesting fat malabsorption.

**Stem Cell**

An unspecialized cell capable of self-renewal and differentiation into one or more mature cell types.

**Stenosis**

Abnormal narrowing of a passage, vessel, valve, or opening.

**Stent**

A tube or scaffold placed inside a vessel or other passage to keep it open.

**Stereognosis**

The ability to identify an object by touch without looking, requiring intact cortical sensory function.

**Stereotaxis**

A technique using a three-dimensional coordinate system to target deep structures, especially in brain procedures.

**Sterilisation**

Destruction or removal of all forms of microbial life, or permanent contraception depending on context.

**Sterility**

Inability to reproduce, or complete absence of viable microorganisms from an object or preparation.

**Sternum**

The breastbone forming the front of the central chest wall.

**Steroid**

A compound with a characteristic four-ring structure, including corticosteroids and sex hormones.

**Stertor**

A low-pitched snoring or rattling breathing sound caused by upper-airway obstruction.

**Stethoscope**

An instrument for listening to sounds from the heart, lungs, blood vessels, and other body structures.

**Stevens-Johnson Syndrome**

A rare severe mucocutaneous reaction, usually to medicines or infection, with epidermal detachment and involvement of multiple mucosal surfaces.

**Synonyms:**

SJS

**Stiffness**

Difficulty or discomfort with movement, often due to joint, muscle, neurologic, or inflammatory disease.

**Stigma**

A mark, characteristic, or social discrediting label; in medicine it may refer to a sign or to harmful social attitudes.

**Stilboestrol**

An older name for diethylstilbestrol, a synthetic estrogen no longer used routinely because of serious risks.



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## Stilet

A slender pointed instrument used to guide, clear, or stiffen a cannula or tube.

## Stillbirth

The birth of a baby showing no signs of life after the locally defined gestational or birth-weight threshold.

## Still's Disease

Systemic juvenile idiopathic arthritis or adult-onset Still disease, inflammatory disorders with fever, arthritis, rash, and systemic inflammation.

### Synonyms:

Arthritis Still (Still's Disease)

## Stings

Injuries caused by venom injected through an insect, animal, or plant structure.

## Stitch

A suture used to close tissue, or a sharp transient pain, often in the side during exercise.

## St John's Wort

A herbal preparation from *Hypericum perforatum* used for mood symptoms but capable of serious drug interactions.

## Stokes-Adams Syndrome

Transient loss of consciousness caused by an intermittent cardiac arrhythmia, usually profound bradycardia or heart block.

## Stoma

A natural opening or a surgically created opening connecting an organ to the skin or another organ.

## Stomach

A muscular digestive organ between the oesophagus and small intestine that stores and begins digestion of food.

## Stomach, Diseases Of

Disorders affecting the stomach, including gastritis, ulcers, motility disorders, obstruction, and tumors.

## Stomach Tube

A tube passed through the mouth or nose into the stomach for drainage, feeding, sampling, or treatment.

## Stomach Washout

Gastric lavage, irrigation and suction of stomach contents in selected poisoning or other emergencies.

## Stomatitis

Inflammation and ulceration of the mouth lining.

## -Stomy

A suffix meaning surgical creation of an opening, such as colostomy or gastrostomy.

## Stone

A hard concretion formed in a body organ or duct, commonly from mineral salts.

## Stools

Feces, the solid waste expelled from the digestive tract.

## Strabismus

Misalignment of the eyes, causing them to point in different directions.

## Strain

An injury from overstretching or tearing a muscle or tendon, or a force applied to tissue.

## Stranguary

An obsolete term for painful, difficult, or frequent urination.

## Strangulation

Compression of a body structure, especially the neck or a hernia, that compromises blood flow or airway.

## Strapping

Application of adhesive tape or bandage to support, protect, or restrict movement of a body part.

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## Strep Throat

Pharyngitis caused by group A Streptococcus.

## Streptococcus

A genus of gram-positive cocci causing infections such as pharyngitis, pneumonia, cellulitis, and endocarditis.

## Streptokinase

A thrombolytic protein that activates plasminogen and dissolves clots; use is limited by bleeding risk and alternatives.

## Streptomycin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic used in selected tuberculosis and other infections.

## Stress

A physiological or psychological response to perceived demands or threat.

## Stress Fractures

Small cracks in bone caused by repetitive loading that exceeds remodeling capacity.

## Striae

Linear bands or streaks in skin, commonly stretch marks caused by dermal connective-tissue change.

## Stridor

A harsh, high-pitched breathing sound caused by upper-airway narrowing.

## Stroke

A sudden neurologic deficit caused by interrupted blood flow to the brain or bleeding within or around it.

## Stroma

The supporting connective tissue of an organ, surrounding its functional cells.

## Strongyloidiasis

A parasitic infection caused by *Strongyloides stercoralis*, which can become life-threatening in immunosuppression.

## Strychnine

A poisonous alkaloid causing painful generalized muscle spasms and convulsions with preserved consciousness.

## Stupor

A state of markedly reduced responsiveness from which a person can be aroused only with vigorous stimulation.

## Stuttering

A speech-fluency disorder involving repetitions, prolongations, blocks, or struggle during speech.

## St Vitus's Dance

An older name for Sydenham chorea, involuntary movements following group A streptococcal infection.

## Stye

A tender localized infection or inflammation of an eyelid gland, also called a hordeolum.

### Synonyms:

Sty (Stye)

## Styptics

Agents that help stop minor bleeding by promoting local vasoconstriction, coagulation, or tissue contraction.

## Sub-

A combining form meaning under, below, or less than normal.

## Subacute

Between acute and chronic in onset, duration, or severity.

## Subacute Combined Degeneration Of The Cord

Spinal-cord degeneration caused mainly by vitamin B12 deficiency, affecting posterior and lateral

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columns.

### **Subacute Sclerosing Panencephalitis**

A rare progressive brain disease occurring years after measles infection, caused by persistent defective measles virus.

### **Subarachnoid Haemorrhage**

Bleeding into the space around the brain containing cerebrospinal fluid, often causing sudden severe headache.

### **Subclavian**

Relating to the vessels or structures beneath the clavicle.

### **Subclinical**

Present without obvious symptoms or signs, often detectable only by testing.

### **Subconscious**

Mental processes outside immediate awareness; it is a psychological term rather than a specific diagnosis.

### **Subdural**

Situated beneath the dura mater.

### **Subinvolution**

Failure of an organ, especially the uterus after childbirth, to return toward its normal size.

### **Subjective**

Based on a person's own experience or report rather than directly observable measurement.

### **Sublimation**

A psychological defense process in which unacceptable impulses are redirected into socially acceptable activity; in chemistry it is solid-to-gas transition.

### **Subluxation**

Partial dislocation of a joint, with some contact between articular surfaces remaining.

### **Submucosa**

The connective-tissue layer beneath a mucous membrane.

### **Subphrenic Abscess**

A collection of pus beneath the diaphragm, usually after abdominal infection or surgery.

### **Substrate**

A substance on which an enzyme acts or a material used by a biochemical pathway.

### **Succussion**

A shaking movement or splash-like sound produced by fluid and gas in a cavity, historically assessed over the chest or abdomen.

### **Sucrose**

Common table sugar, a disaccharide of glucose and fructose.

### **Suction**

Removal of fluid, secretions, or material using negative pressure.

### **Sudden Unexpected Death In Infancy**

Unexpected death of an infant, requiring investigation to determine whether it is explained or unexplained.

### **Sudek's Atrophy**

An older name for complex regional pain syndrome with pain, swelling, autonomic change, and regional bone loss.

### **Sudorifics**

Substances that promote sweating.

### **Suffocation**

Inability to breathe adequately because of airway obstruction, oxygen deprivation, compression, or another cause.

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## **Suicide**

Death caused by intentional self-inflicted action; suicidal thoughts and behavior require urgent, compassionate assessment.

## **Sulcus**

A groove or furrow on an organ or surface, especially the brain or heart.

## **Sulfamethoxazole**

A sulfonamide antibiotic used commonly with trimethoprim in selected infections.

## **Sulfasalazine**

An anti-inflammatory medicine used for inflammatory bowel disease and rheumatoid or other inflammatory arthritis.

## **Sulfinpyrazone**

An older uricosuric medicine used historically for gout.

## **Sulphonylureas**

Oral medicines that stimulate pancreatic insulin release to lower blood glucose in type 2 diabetes.

## **Sumatriptan**

A serotonin 5-HT<sub>1B/1D</sub> agonist used for acute migraine and cluster headache attacks.

## **Summer Diarrhoea**

An older term for seasonal diarrheal illness, often referring to infectious diarrhea in children.

## **Sunburn**

Inflammatory skin injury caused by excessive ultraviolet radiation.

## **Super-**

A combining form meaning above, excessive, or superior.

## **Superficial**

Near the surface of the body or an organ.

## **Supination**

Rotation of the forearm so the palm faces upward or forward, or a related foot movement.

## **Supine**

Lying on the back with the face upward.

## **Suppository**

A solid preparation inserted into the rectum, vagina, or urethra where it dissolves or melts.

## **Suppression**

Reduction or inhibition of a function, response, symptom, or process.

## **Suppuration**

Formation or discharge of pus.

## **Supra-**

A combining form meaning above or beyond.

## **Suprapubic**

Situated above the pubic bone.

## **Suprarenal Glands**

The adrenal glands located above the kidneys.

## **Supraventricular Tachycardia**

A rapid heart rhythm arising above the ventricles, often beginning and ending abruptly.

### **Synonyms:**

SVT

## **Suramin**

An antiparasitic medicine used mainly for selected African trypanosomiasis.

## **Surfactant**

A substance that lowers surface tension; pulmonary surfactant prevents alveolar collapse.

## **Surgery**

Treatment involving operative manipulation of tissues or organs.

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## **Surrogate**

A substitute or proxy; in medicine, a surrogate endpoint is an intermediate measure used in place of a clinical outcome.

## **Susceptibility**

The likelihood of being affected by a disease, exposure, drug, or microorganism.

## **Suture**

A stitch or material used to close or join tissue.

## **Swab**

A sterile absorbent applicator or the specimen collected with it from a body surface or cavity.

## **Swan-Ganz Catheter**

A pulmonary-artery catheter used to measure pressures and cardiac output in selected critically ill patients.

## **Sweat**

Fluid secreted by sweat glands, helping regulate body temperature.

## **Sweat Glands**

Eccrine and apocrine glands that produce sweat or related secretions.

## **Sycosis Barbae**

Chronic folliculitis of the beard area, usually caused by bacterial infection and ingrown hairs.

## **Sydenham's Chorea**

A post-streptococcal autoimmune movement disorder causing involuntary, irregular movements and emotional or behavioral change.

## **Sympathetic**

Relating to the sympathetic division of the autonomic nervous system or to shared feeling, depending on context.

## **Sympathetic Nervous System**

The autonomic division that prepares the body for activity or stress by increasing heart rate and altering vascular, airway, and digestive function.

## **Sympathomimetic Drugs**

Medicines that mimic sympathetic nervous-system activity, often by stimulating alpha or beta adrenergic receptors.

## **Symphysis**

A joint in which bones are united by fibrocartilage, such as the pubic symphysis.

## **Symptom**

A subjective experience reported by a patient, such as pain, nausea, or breathlessness.

## **Syn-**

A combining form meaning together, with, or joined.

## **Synapse**

A junction where a neuron communicates with another neuron, muscle, or gland.

## **Syncope**

A sudden, brief loss of consciousness and postural tone caused by temporary global cerebral hypoperfusion, followed by spontaneous, usually complete recovery. Common mechanisms are reflex syncope, orthostatic hypotension, and cardiac disease; prolonged confusion or seizure-like features require evaluation for another cause.

## **Syndactyly**

Congenital fusion or webbing of adjacent fingers or toes.

## **Syndrome**

A recognizable pattern of symptoms, signs, or findings that occur together.

## **Synechiae**

Abnormal adhesions between tissues, especially within the eye, uterus, or nasal cavity.

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**Synergist**

A muscle, drug, or factor that works together with another to produce or enhance an effect.

**Synostosis**

Fusion of two bones by bone tissue, congenital or acquired.

**Synovectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of an inflamed synovial membrane.

**Synovial Membrane**

The lining of a synovial joint that produces lubricating synovial fluid.

**Synovitis**

Inflammation of a synovial membrane, causing swelling, pain, and restricted movement.

**Synovium**

The synovial membrane and its associated tissue lining a joint or tendon sheath.

**Synthetic**

Produced by chemical or laboratory processes rather than directly obtained in its natural form.

**Syphilis**

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Treponema pallidum*, progressing through primary, secondary, latent, and sometimes tertiary stages.

**Syringe**

A device with a barrel and plunger used to withdraw or inject fluids.

**Syringe Drivers**

Small battery-powered pumps that deliver medicines continuously or at programmed intervals through a syringe.

**Syringomyelia**

A fluid-filled cavity within the spinal cord that can

cause pain, sensory loss, weakness, or autonomic dysfunction.

**Systemic**

Affecting the whole body or relating to an entire system rather than a localized site.

**Systemic Lupus Erythematosus (SLE)**

A chronic autoimmune disease that can affect skin, joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, heart, lungs, and other organs.

**Systole**

The phase of the cardiac cycle during which a chamber contracts and ejects blood.

**Systolic Pressure**

The maximum arterial pressure during ventricular contraction, recorded as the upper number of a blood-pressure reading.

**Synonyms:**

Seasonal affective disorder

**Saline**

A sterile water solution containing sodium chloride, commonly used for fluids, irrigation, or drug delivery.

**Synonyms:**

Normal saline

**Sarcolemma**

The specialized cell membrane surrounding a muscle fiber.

**Satisficer**

A person who chooses an option that meets acceptable criteria without seeking the absolute best option.

**Sausage Digit**

Diffuse swelling of an entire finger or toe, often seen with inflammatory arthritis.

**Synonyms:**

Dactylitis



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### Scapulothoracic Joint

The functional gliding connection between the scapula and the back of the chest wall.

### Schlemm's Canal

A circular channel that drains aqueous humor from the eye.

**Synonyms:**

Canal of Schlemm

### Scintillations

Perceived flashes or zigzag lines, often occurring during a migraine aura.

### Secondary Osteoporosis

Bone loss caused by another illness, medication, or prolonged immobility.

### Sed Rate

A blood test measuring how quickly red blood cells settle, used as a nonspecific marker of inflammation.

**Synonyms:**

Erythrocyte sedimentation rate; ESR

### Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulators

Medicines that activate estrogen receptors in some tissues and block them in others.

**Synonyms:**

SERMs

### Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors

Antidepressants that increase serotonin signaling by reducing its reuptake into nerve cells.

**Synonyms:**

SSRIs

### Self-Help Group

A peer group in which members support one another while changing a harmful behavior or coping with a problem.

**Synonyms:**

Support group

### Seminal Vesicles

Glands behind the bladder that produce much of the fluid in semen.

### Senescence

Gradual biological decline associated with aging.

**Synonyms:**

Biological aging

### Sensate Focus Techniques

Structured touch exercises used in sex therapy to reduce performance pressure and improve intimacy.

**Synonyms:**

Sensate focus

### Sensitized

State of having preformed antibodies against human leukocyte antigens (HLA); complicates transplant matching and increases rejection risk.

### SERMs

Selective estrogen receptor modulators that have estrogen-like effects in some tissues and blocking effects in others.

**Synonyms:**

Selective estrogen receptor modulators

### Seroma

A pocket of clear fluid that develops near a surgical incision or injured tissue.

### Serotonin

A neurotransmitter involved in mood, sleep, appetite, and pain regulation.

**Synonyms:**

5-hydroxytryptamine; 5-HT

### Sesamoiditis

Inflammation and pain around a small sesamoid bone, often beneath the big toe.

### Set

A group of consecutive repetitions of an exercise.

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### Short-Term Memory

The temporary storage and use of information over seconds to minutes.

**Synonyms:**

Working memory

### Sigmoidoscopy

Sigmoidoscopy examines sigmoidoscopy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Signature Strengths

Personal character strengths that a person values and naturally uses.

### Silent Heart Attack

A myocardial infarction without recognized pain or typical warning symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

Unrecognized myocardial infarction

### Silent Ischemia

Inadequate blood flow to heart muscle without noticeable symptoms.

**Synonyms:**

Asymptomatic ischemia

### Single-Photon Absorptiometry

An older technique using gamma rays to measure bone density, usually in an arm or peripheral bone.

**Synonyms:**

SPA

### Sinus Node

The heart's natural pacemaker, located in the right atrium.

**Synonyms:**

Sinoatrial node

### Six Minute Walk

Functional exercise test measuring the distance a patient can walk in six minutes; used to assess cardiopulmonary capacity and functional status.

### Skeletal Muscles

Muscles attached to bones that produce voluntary movement.

### Smoldering Multiple Myeloma

An asymptomatic plasma-cell disorder with increased clonal plasma cells or monoclonal protein but no myeloma-defining organ damage; it requires risk-based monitoring for progression to active multiple myeloma.

**Synonyms:**

Voluntary muscles

### Skin Resurfacing

Procedures that improve skin texture or pigmentation by removing or remodeling superficial skin layers.

### Sleep Architecture

The pattern and organization of sleep stages across a sleep period.

### Sleep Spindles

Brief bursts of rhythmic brain activity during stage 2 non-REM sleep.

### Sling

A supportive device or surgically placed strip used to support an injured limb or urinary structures.

### Slipped Disk

A spinal disk that bulges or herniates through a tear in its outer layer.

**Synonyms:**

Herniated disk

### Slipped Vertebra

Forward displacement of one vertebra relative to the one below it.

**Synonyms:**

Spondylolisthesis

### Slit Lamp

An instrument using magnification and a narrow beam of light to examine the eye.

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**Synonyms:**

Biomicroscope

**Slow-Twitch Fiber**

A muscle fiber adapted for sustained, aerobic activity and fatigue resistance.

**Synonyms:**

Type I muscle fiber

**Slow-Wave Sleep**

Deep non-REM sleep characterized by slow brain waves and reduced responsiveness.

**Synonyms:**

Deep sleep

**SMART**

A goal-setting framework emphasizing specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and time-bound goals.

**Synonyms:**

SMART goals

**Social Worker**

Healthcare professional providing psychosocial support, resource coordination, and counseling for patients and families throughout the transplant process.

**Somatization**

Expression of psychological distress through physical symptoms.

**Somniloquy**

Talking during sleep.

**Synonyms:**

Sleep talking

**Sorbitol**

A sugar alcohol used as a sweetener and, in larger amounts, as an osmotic laxative.

**Spacer**

A chamber used with a metered-dose inhaler to improve delivery of medicine to the lungs.

**Synonyms:**

Valved holding chamber

**Sphincter**

A ring-shaped muscle that regulates an opening by contracting and relaxing.

**Spinal Tap**

A procedure that withdraws cerebrospinal fluid from the lower spinal canal for testing.

**Synonyms:**

Lumbar puncture

**Spinous Process**

The posterior bony projection of a vertebra to which muscles and ligaments attach.

**Splenic Flexure Syndrome**

Left-upper-abdominal pain caused by gas trapped at the bend between the transverse and descending colon.

**Spongy Bone**

Porous trabecular bone found inside many bones, especially near joints.

**Synonyms:**

Cancellous bone; trabecular bone

**Squamous Cell**

A thin, flat epithelial cell.

**Stable Angina**

Predictable exertional chest pain caused by temporary inadequate coronary blood flow.

**Synonyms:**

Chronic stable angina

**Stable Coronary Artery Disease**

Coronary artery narrowing causing a consistent, predictable pattern of angina.

**Synonyms:**

Stable ischemic heart disease

**Stages Of Change**

A model describing gradual phases people pass

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through while changing behavior.

**Synonyms:**

Transtheoretical model

**Standardized Extract**

An herbal extract adjusted to contain a specified amount of a selected constituent.

**Statins**

Cholesterol-lowering medicines that inhibit HMG-CoA reductase.

**Synonyms:**

HMG-CoA reductase inhibitors

**Steroids**

Hormone-like medicines or compounds with a four-ring chemical structure; corticosteroids are used to reduce inflammation.

**Synonyms:**

Corticosteroids

**Stimulant**

A substance that increases activity of the central nervous system or other body systems.

**Stratum Corneum**

The outermost layer of the epidermis, composed mainly of dead keratinized cells.

**Strength**

The ability of a muscle or muscle group to exert force.

**Strength Training**

Exercise using resistance to increase muscle strength and capacity.

**Synonyms:**

Resistance training; weight training

**Stress Response**

Physiological changes that prepare the body to respond to a perceived threat.

**Synonyms:**

Fight-or-flight response

**Stressors**

Events, conditions, or circumstances that trigger a stress response.

**Stria**

A line, streak, or band in tissue, such as a stretch mark.

**Synonyms:**

Striae

**Stricture**

Abnormal narrowing of a hollow body passage.

**Subarachnoid Space**

The space between the arachnoid and pia mater containing cerebrospinal fluid.

**Subcutaneous**

Subcutaneous means beneath the skin; injections by this route deliver medicine into the fatty tissue between skin and muscle.

**Subendocardial Myocytes**

Heart-muscle cells in the inner layer of the myocardium, which are especially vulnerable to reduced blood flow.

**S3 Gallop Pathology**

A third heart sound produced during rapid ventricular filling. In some adults it may indicate volume overload or ventricular dysfunction, although it can be physiologic in children, young adults, and pregnancy. Its significance depends on the complete clinical assessment.

**S4 Gallop Pathology**

A fourth heart sound indicates atrial contraction against a stiff ventricle (decreased compliance). Associated with left ventricular hypertrophy from hypertension, aortic stenosis, and hypertrophic cardiomyopathy. S4 is best heard at the apex with the bell, and is accentuated by exertion, expiration, and isorhythmic AV dissociation.

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## Sacral Nerve Stimulation

Neuromodulation for urinary/fecal incontinence, constipation. Sacral nerve root (S3) stimulation. Implantable pulse generator + electrode. Indications: refractory urge incontinence, fecal incontinence, non-obstructive urinary retention.

## Sacral Nerve Stimulator

An implanted device that delivers electrical stimulation to sacral nerves to alter bladder, bowel, or pelvic-floor function in selected patients.

## Sacral Vertebrae

Five vertebrae fused to form the sacrum. They transmit body weight from the vertebral column to the pelvic girdle and contain anterior and posterior sacral foramina for spinal nerves.

## Sacroiliac Joint

The synovial joint between the sacrum and the ilium (auricular surfaces), forming the connection between the axial skeleton and the pelvis. The sacroiliac joint is reinforced by strong ligaments (anterior, interosseous, and posterior sacroiliac ligaments, sacrotuberous and sacrospinous ligaments).

## Sacroiliitis

Inflammation of one or both sacroiliac joints, causing pain in the lower back, buttock, or posterior thigh that may worsen with prolonged rest. Causes include axial spondyloarthritis, psoriatic or enteropathic arthritis, infection, trauma, and degenerative disease.

## Sacrum

Large triangular bone from 5 fused sacral vertebrae between the hip bones. Articulates with L5 superiorly and coccyx inferiorly. The sacral promontory is an obstetric landmark. Contains 4 pairs of sacral foramina. Forms the posterior pelvic wall.

## Safety Plan

A collaboratively written, practical plan for responding to escalating suicidal thoughts or emotional crisis. It identifies warning signs, internal coping strategies, supportive contacts, professional resources, and

methods to restrict access to lethal means.

## Sagittal Plane

A vertical plane that divides the body or an organ into right and left sides.

## Salbutamol (Albuterol)

A selective beta-2 adrenergic agonist bronchodilator used for acute relief and prevention of bronchospasm in asthma and COPD. Relaxes airway smooth muscle; short-acting (SABA), onset 5-15 minutes, duration 4-6 hours via inhaler or nebulizer. Adverse effects: tremor, tachycardia, palpitations, hypokalemia, and headache.

### Synonyms:

Albuterol

## Salicylate

A group of compounds that includes aspirin and has analgesic, antipyretic, and anti-inflammatory effects.

## Salicylate Toxicity

Poisoning caused by excessive aspirin or another salicylate, potentially producing vomiting, ringing in the ears, fever, abnormal breathing, confusion, and acid-base disturbances.

## Saline Infusion Sonohysterography

Ultrasound evaluation of uterus using saline contrast. Evaluates intrauterine pathology.

## Saliva

Secretion of salivary glands (1-1.5 L/day). Functions: lubrication, digestion (amylase), buffering, antimicrobial, remineralization. Xerostomia (dry mouth) increases caries risk. Causes: medications, Sjogren syndrome, radiation, dehydration.

## Salivary Gland

Any exocrine gland that secretes saliva into the oral cavity. The major paired glands are the parotid, submandibular, and sublingual glands; numerous minor glands occur throughout the oral mucosa.

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## Salivary Gland Cancer

A rare malignancy most often arising in the parotid gland. Histologic types include mucoepidermoid carcinoma, adenoid cystic carcinoma, and acinic cell carcinoma; facial nerve preservation is a key surgical consideration.

## Salivary Gland Infection

Infection of a salivary gland, usually bacterial and often involving the parotid or submandibular gland. Painful swelling, fever, dry mouth, and purulent drainage from the duct may occur.

## Salivary Gland Scintigraphy

Salivary gland function assessment using Tc-99m pertechnetate. Used for Sjogren syndrome, obstruction, radiation sialadenitis.

## Salivary Gland Tumors

Tumors arising in the salivary glands. Many are benign, especially in the parotid gland; pleomorphic adenoma is a common benign type. Malignant types include mucoepidermoid, adenoid cystic, and acinic cell carcinoma.

### Synonyms:

Tumor, Salivary Gland

## Salivation

The secretion of saliva by the salivary glands.

## Salmonella

A genus of Gram-negative, facultatively anaerobic, rod-shaped bacteria in the Enterobacteriaceae family. It includes non-typhoidal strains that cause gastroenteritis and typhoidal strains that can cause enteric fever.

## Salmonellosis

Infection with Salmonella bacteria (non-typhoidal), typically acquired from contaminated food (eggs, poultry, meat). Presents with acute gastroenteritis: diarrhea, fever, and abdominal cramps within 6-72 hours of ingestion. Self-limited in immunocompetent patients. Bacteremia can occur, especially in immunocompromised.

### Synonyms:

Salmonella Food Poisoning (Salmonellosis)

## Salpingectomy

Surgical removal of a fallopian tube. It may be used to treat a tubal ectopic pregnancy, hydrosalpinx, or other tubal disease. The approach and whether the tube is removed depend on the clinical condition, fertility plans, and the state of the opposite tube.

## Salpingitis

Inflammation of the fallopian tubes, most commonly caused by ascending infection from the lower genital tract. Salpingitis is a component of pelvic inflammatory disease and is often bilateral.

## Salpingo-Oophorectomy

Surgical removal of one or both fallopian tubes and ovaries. Bilateral salpingo-oophorectomy treats and stages ovarian cancer and is used as risk-reducing surgery in BRCA mutation carriers.

## Salpingography

Contrast imaging of fallopian tubes. Part of hysterosalpingography.

## Salpingostomy (Salpingotomy)

A fertility-preserving surgical procedure for tubal ectopic pregnancy: a linear incision on the antimesenteric border of the fallopian tube to remove the ectopic gestation, leaving the tube in situ. Indications: unruptured ectopic, desire for future fertility, contralateral tubal damage or absence.

### Synonyms:

Salpingotomy

## Saltatory Conduction

The rapid propagation of action potentials along myelinated nerve fibers, where the action potential appears to "jump" from one Node of Ranvier to the next. Myelin (produced by Schwann cells in the PNS and oligodendrocytes in the CNS) insulates the axon, preventing ion flow across the internodal membrane.



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## Salvage Therapy

Treatment given for cancer that has not responded to, or has returned after, an earlier course of treatment.

## Sandhoff Disease

An autosomal-recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficiency of beta-hexosaminidase A and B, leading to accumulation of GM2 ganglioside. It causes progressive neurodegeneration, developmental regression, seizures, hypotonia, and sometimes organ enlargement.

## Sandpaper Tooth

Rough enamel surface retains plaque. May indicate early demineralization or fluorosis.

## Saphenous Vein

A superficial vein of the lower limb that drains the foot and leg. The great and small saphenous veins are clinically important in venous disease and may be used as graft material in selected vascular or cardiac bypass procedures.

## SAPHO Syndrome

A rare inflammatory disorder involving synovitis, acne, pustulosis, hyperostosis, and osteitis. It commonly affects the anterior chest wall, spine, or jaw and may resemble infection or malignancy. Diagnosis is clinical and treatment may include anti-inflammatory or specialist immunomodulatory therapy.

## Sarcoidosis

Sarcoidosis is multisystem granulomatous inflammation, commonly affecting lungs and lymph nodes but also skin, eyes, heart, nerves, and other organs. It commonly affects the lungs and lymph nodes but may involve the skin, eyes, heart, nervous system, or other organs.

### Synonyms:

Arthritis Sarcoid (Sarcoidosis)

## Sarcoidosis Skin Manifestations

Cutaneous sarcoidosis affects 25 percent of patients

with systemic sarcoidosis.

## Sarcoma

A malignant tumor arising from connective or supporting tissues, including bone, cartilage, fat, muscle, and blood vessels. Examples include osteosarcoma, liposarcoma, and rhabdomyosarcoma.

## Sarcopenia

Age-related loss of muscle mass and function. Prevalence increases with age. Risk factors: reduced protein intake, decreased physical activity, chronic disease. Assessment: grip strength, gait speed, muscle mass measurement. Treatment: protein supplementation, resistance exercise, vitamin D, hormonal therapy if deficient.

## Sarcopenic Obesity

The coexistence of excess adiposity with reduced skeletal-muscle mass, strength, or physical performance. It increases risks of disability, falls, metabolic disease, and poor surgical outcomes and requires assessment beyond body-mass index alone.

## Sarcoptes Scabiei

A mite that causes scabies, a contagious skin infestation transmitted by prolonged skin-to-skin contact. The female mite burrows into the stratum corneum, laying eggs along the burrow, which appears as a greyish, serpiginous line. The life cycle from egg to adult takes approximately 10-14 days.

## SARS-CoV-2

A coronavirus belonging to the Coronaviridae family that causes COVID-19. SARS-CoV-2 has a positive-sense single-stranded RNA genome and a spike glycoprotein that mediates attachment to ACE2 receptors. The virus replicates in the cytoplasm using its own RNA-dependent RNA polymerase.

## Satiety

Feeling of fullness after eating. Affected by meal composition, volume, fiber, protein. Satiety hormones: CCK, PYY, GLP-1.

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## Saturated Fat

Solid at room temperature. Sources: meat, dairy, coconut oil, palm oil. Controversial cardiovascular effects. Current guidelines limit intake.

## Saturation

Occupancy of available binding, metabolic, transport, or elimination capacity such that further increases in concentration or dose produce a nonlinear response. Saturable metabolism can cause disproportionate rises in plasma concentration and toxicity.

## Scabies

Scabies is infestation by *Sarcoptes scabiei* mites, causing intense nighttime itching and a characteristic rash or burrows, with spread through close contact. mite *Sarcoptes scabiei* var. *hominis*. The hallmark symptom is severe, generalized pruritus that characteristically worsens at night, driven by a hypersensitivity reaction to the mite's proteins, eggs, and feces.

### Synonyms:

Sarcoptic Mange (Scabies)

## Scaffold

Three-dimensional structure for tissue engineering. Porous, biodegradable. Cells populate scaffold.

## Scaling And Root Planing

Nonsurgical periodontal instrumentation that removes supra- and subgingival deposits and smooths contaminated root surfaces. It reduces inflammation and pocket depth in appropriate patients but does not regenerate lost periodontal attachment by itself.

## Scalp Psoriasis

Psoriasis affecting the scalp, causing sharply demarcated red plaques covered by silvery scale that may extend beyond the hairline. It can itch, crack, or bleed and is not contagious. Treatment may include medicated shampoos, topical corticosteroids, vitamin-D analogues, or systemic therapy for extensive disease.

### Synonyms:

Psoriasis Of The Scalp (Scalp Psoriasis)

## Scalpel

Surgical knife with interchangeable blades. Blade numbers indicate size and shape. #10: common for incisions. #11: puncture. #15: precise work.

## Scalpel Handle

Handle for holding scalpel blades. #3 handle common.

## Scaphoid

Largest proximal carpal row bone on the radial wrist side. Most commonly fractured carpal bone from falls on an outstretched hand. Unique distal blood supply makes waist fractures prone to proximal fragment avascular necrosis. Anatomical snuffbox tenderness is characteristic.

## Scaphoid Fractures

Scaphoid fractures: most common carpal fracture (young males, FOOSH). Classification: Herbert: A (incomplete), B (complete: B1 distal waist, B2 proximal waist, B3 proximal pole, B4 distal tubercle, B5 transverse). Vascularity: retrograde from distal radius -> proximal pole at risk for AVN.

## Scapula

Flat triangular bone on the posterior thorax between ribs 2-7. Key features: acromion, coracoid process, glenoid cavity, spine, supraspinous/infraspinous fossae. Stabilized by 17 muscles and serves as rotator cuff attachment. Has 3 borders, 3 angles, and 2 surfaces. Fractures are uncommon, usually from high-energy trauma.

## Scar Management

Measures used to reduce symptoms and abnormal scar formation. Options include silicone products, pressure therapy, massage, corticosteroid injections, or other specialist treatments, depending on the scar and its cause.

## Scarlatina

Scarlet fever, an illness caused by toxin-producing

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group A Streptococcus and characterized by sore throat, fever, and a fine rough-textured rash.

**Synonyms:**

Scarlet Fever (Scarlatina)

**Scarlet Fever**

A toxin-mediated illness caused by Group A Streptococcus producing erythrogenic toxin. Presents with fever, pharyngitis, and a characteristic diffuse, erythematous, sandpaper-textured rash that blanches with pressure. Circumoral pallor, Pastia lines (linear petechiae in skin folds), and strawberry tongue are classic findings.

**Scarring Alopecia**

Permanent hair loss caused by destruction and fibrosis of the hair follicle. Causes include lichen planopilaris, discoid lupus, central centrifugal cicatricial alopecia, folliculitis decalvans, and severe infection; early diagnosis and biopsy can prevent progression.

**Scatter Correction**

Correction for scattered photons. Dual energy window method.

**Scatter Events**

Photons deflected from original path. Corrected by energy windowing and scatter correction algorithms.

**Scavenging System**

The anesthesia gas scavenging system collects and removes waste anesthetic gases from the operating room environment to protect staff from chronic exposure. Active scavenging uses negative pressure from vacuum source; passive scavenging vents to exhaust through gravity.

**Schatzki Ring**

Thin circumferential mucosal ring located at the squamocolumnar junction of the distal esophagus at the superior margin of a hiatal hernia. The ring is composed of mucosa and submucosa. May be asymptomatic or cause episodic dysphagia particularly to solid food and acute food bolus impaction.

**Synonyms:**

Ring Schatzki (Schatzki Ring) Strictures Esophagus (Schatzki Ring)

**Schedule I**

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with high misuse potential and no accepted medical use under federal law.

**Schedule II**

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with accepted medical uses but high misuse potential.

**Schedule III**

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with lower misuse potential than Schedule II drugs.

**Schedule IV**

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with accepted medical uses and lower misuse potential than Schedule III drugs.

**Schedule V**

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with the lowest level of misuse potential among the federal schedules.

**Schilling Test**

A historical test of vitamin B12 absorption, formerly used to investigate pernicious anaemia and intestinal malabsorption. It has largely been replaced by serum vitamin B12, methylmalonic acid, homocysteine, and intrinsic-factor antibody testing.

**Schistocytes**

Fragmented, helmet-shaped, or triangular red blood cells produced by mechanical shearing as erythrocytes pass through obstructed or fibrin-laden microvessels.

**Schistosoma Haematobium**

A parasitic blood fluke that can cause urinary schistosomiasis, including hematuria and chronic injury

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of the urinary tract.

### **Schistosomiasis**

A parasitic disease caused by *Schistosoma* blood flukes acquired through freshwater exposure, potentially causing intestinal or urinary inflammation, bleeding, liver disease, or chronic organ damage.

#### **Synonyms:**

bilharzia, caused by blood flukes of the genus. Bilharzia (Schistosomiasis)

### **Schizencephaly**

A rare brain malformation characterized by a full-thickness, gray matter-lined cleft extending from the pial surface to the lateral ventricle. Caused by early focal neuronal migration abnormalities, often associated with prenatal vascular disruption or COL4A1 mutations. Closed-lip (Type I): the cleft walls are apposed.

### **Schizoaffective Disorder**

A disorder characterized by an uninterrupted period of illness during which there is a major mood episode concurrent with criterion A of schizophrenia (delusions, hallucinations, disorganized speech, grossly disorganized or catatonic behavior, or negative symptoms).

### **Schizoid Personality Disorder**

A pattern of detachment from social relationships with a restricted range of emotional expression.

#### **Synonyms:**

Personality Disorder, Schizoid

### **Schizophrenia**

Schizophrenia is a chronic psychotic disorder involving delusions, hallucinations, disorganized thought or behavior, negative symptoms, and impaired functioning. delusions, disorganized thinking) and negative symptoms (avolition, alogia, anhedonia, blunted affect), with cognitive impairment and functional decline. Diagnosis: at least two core symptoms for  $\geq 1$  month with continuous signs for  $\geq 6$  months.

### **Schizotypal Personality Disorder**

A pattern of social and interpersonal deficits marked by acute discomfort with and reduced capacity for close relationships, cognitive or perceptual distortions, and eccentricities of behavior.

#### **Synonyms:**

Personality Disorder, Schizotypal

### **Schnitzler Syndrome**

A rare autoinflammatory syndrome characterized by chronic urticarial rash, intermittent fever, bone pain, arthralgia or arthritis, and elevated inflammatory markers, usually with a monoclonal IgM protein and less commonly IgG.

### **School-Based Rehabilitation**

Therapy and other support services provided in a school setting to help a child participate in education and daily school activities.

### **Schwannoma**

A benign peripheral nerve sheath tumor arising from Schwann cells. It presents as a solitary, slow-growing, painless nodule along a peripheral nerve course. It can be moved laterally but not longitudinally along the nerve. Vestibular schwannoma (acoustic neuroma) arises from CN VIII. Diagnosis is by MRI.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neurilemmoma

### **Sciatic Nerve**

Body's largest nerve (L4-S3), formed from the lumbosacral plexus, exiting via the greater sciatic foramen below the piriformis. Descends in the posterior thigh, dividing into tibial and common peroneal nerves at the popliteal fossa. Innervates hamstrings and provides lower leg/foot motor/sensory innervation via its branches.

### **Sciatica**

Sciatica is radiating leg pain or sensory symptoms along a lumbosacral nerve-root distribution, commonly from disk herniation or spinal narrowing. through the buttock and down the posterior thigh to the foot. Most commonly caused by lumbar disc

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herniation compressing the nerve root (L4-L5 or L5-S1). Other causes: spinal stenosis, spondylolisthesis, piriformis syndrome, and epidural abscess.

**Synonyms:**

Sciatic Neuritis (Sciatica)

**Scimitar Syndrome**

A congenital cardiopulmonary anomaly involving partial or total anomalous pulmonary venous return from the right lung to the inferior vena cava, often with right-lung hypoplasia and dextroposition of the heart. It may cause recurrent respiratory infection, pulmonary hypertension, or heart failure.

**Scintillation**

The emission of light by a material after it absorbs ionizing radiation. Scintillation detectors use this light to measure radiation.

**Scintillation Crystal**

Sodium iodide doped with thallium (NaI:Tl) crystal converts gamma rays to light photons. Coupled to photomultiplier tubes.

**Scissors**

Cutting instruments. Types: Mayo (tissue), Metzenbaum (delicate), suture.

**Scissors (Surgical)**

Cutting instruments used to divide tissue, sutures, dressings, or other materials during medical procedures.

**Synonyms:**

Surgical

**Scissors (Vascular)**

A surgical instrument with two blades used to cut tissue, sutures, dressings, or other materials during vascular procedures.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

**Sclera**

The sclera is the tough white outer coat of the eye that protects the globe and provides attachment for

eye muscles.

**Scleral Buckling**

A retinal-detachment repair procedure in which a silicone band or buckle is placed around the outside of the eye to support the retinal break and reduce traction.

**Scleritis**

Scleritis is painful inflammation of the sclera, often associated with autoimmune disease and capable of threatening vision.

**Synonyms:**

Inflammation Sclera (Scleritis)

**Scleroderma**

Scleroderma is an autoimmune connective-tissue disease causing skin thickening and variable fibrosis or vascular injury in the gastrointestinal tract, lungs, kidneys, or heart.

**Synonyms:**

Arthritis Scleroderma (Scleroderma) Sclerosis, Systemic

**Scleromyxedema**

A rare, chronic, progressive mucinosis characterised by generalised papular and sclerodermoid thickening of the skin with firm, waxy papules in a "peau d'orange" pattern, most prominently on the face, neck, and hands.

**Sclerosing Sialadenitis**

A chronic fibrosing inflammation of the salivary glands characterized by progressive glandular enlargement and firmness, sometimes associated with IgG4-related disease.

**Sclerosteosis**

A rare inherited sclerosing bone dysplasia characterized by progressive thickening of the skull and long bones, tall stature or syndactyly in some forms, and possible cranial-nerve compression. Hearing loss, facial palsy, headache, and raised intracranial pressure may occur.

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## Scoliosis

Scoliosis is a three-dimensional sideways curvature and rotation of the spine, which may be idiopathic, congenital, neuromuscular, or degenerative.

### Synonyms:

Spinal Curvature

## Scotoma

A focal area of diminished or absent vision within an otherwise intact visual field, classified by location and morphology.

## Screening

Testing people without symptoms to identify a disease or an increased risk of disease. The appropriate test, age range, interval, and follow-up depend on the condition, individual risk, and current guidance; screening benefits must be balanced against harms.

## Screening (Geriatric)

Detection of disease in asymptomatic elderly. Balance benefits vs. harms, life expectancy, preferences. Examples: bone density, abdominal aortic aneurysm, colorectal cancer (individualized), depression, falls.

### Synonyms:

Geriatric

## Screening Guidelines

Recommendations describing who should be screened for a disease, which test to use, and when to begin or repeat testing.

## Screening Program

An organized public-health service that systematically invites a defined population to undergo testing for an asymptomatic condition, with quality-assured follow-up, diagnosis, treatment, and evaluation of benefits and harms.

## Screening Test

A test applied to people without symptoms or a known diagnosis to identify those at increased risk of a condition. A screening result usually requires a diagnostic or confirmatory evaluation before treat-

ment is initiated.

## Screws

Threaded devices used to hold bone fragments together or attach implants to bone.

## Scrofula

Tuberculous infection of cervical lymph nodes, producing chronic neck swellings that may suppurate or form draining sinuses; nontuberculous mycobacteria can cause a similar presentation.

## Scrotal Calcinosis

The deposition of calcium within the scrotal skin, presenting as multiple, firm, whitish, painless nodules on the scrotum, which may be solitary or numerous and may ulcerate. The exact aetiology is debated and may involve dystrophic calcification of pre-existing epidermal inclusion cysts, dermal cysts, or eccrine duct abnormalities.

## Scrotal Infection

Infection of the scrotal skin or underlying structures, which may cause redness, swelling, warmth, pain, or drainage. Rapidly worsening pain, fever, discoloration, or severe swelling is an emergency because serious soft-tissue infection must be excluded.

## Scrotal Pain

Pain in the scrotum caused by infection, trauma, hernia, fluid collections, varicocele, or testicular torsion. Sudden severe pain, nausea, a high-riding testis, or abnormal testicular position requires immediate assessment for torsion.

## Scrotum

The scrotum is the external skin-and-muscle sac containing the testes and epididymides; its muscles help regulate testicular temperature, and swelling or pain may indicate infection, torsion, hernia, or tumor. spermatic cords. The scrotal wall has multiple layers reflecting the abdominal wall layers.

## Scurvy

Vitamin C deficiency causing impaired collagen



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formation, with bleeding gums, easy bruising, petechiae, poor wound healing, anemia, bone pain, and fatigue.

### **Seasonal Affective Disorder**

A specifier of recurrent major depressive episodes that occur at a specific time of year, most commonly winter (with remission in spring/summer). Symptoms: hypersomnia, hyperphagia with carbohydrate craving, weight gain, fatigue, and low energy.

### **Sebaceous Gland**

A small gland in the skin that secretes sebum (oil) into hair follicles to lubricate and waterproof the skin and hair.

### **Seborrheic Dermatitis**

A chronic inflammatory skin condition affecting sebum-rich areas: scalp, face (nasolabial folds, eyebrows), chest, and intertriginous areas. Presents with erythematous patches with greasy, yellowish scales. Dandruff is a mild form. More common and severe in Parkinson disease, HIV/AIDS, and Down syndrome.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dermatitis, Seborrheic

### **Seborrheic Keratoses**

Common, benign, epidermal skin tumors presenting as waxy, stuck-on, pigmented plaques with a rough, verrucous surface, typically appearing on the trunk and face of middle-aged and older adults. They are the most common benign skin neoplasm and are caused by keratinocyte proliferation.

### **Seborrheic Keratosis**

A benign epidermal tumor appearing as stuck-on, waxy, hyperpigmented plaques with a verrucous surface. They are extremely common in older adults and increase in number with age. Seborrheic keratoses are not premalignant.

#### **Synonyms:**

Keratosis, Seborrheic

### **Seborrhoea**

A chronic inflammatory skin condition affecting sebum-rich areas: scalp, face (nasolabial folds, eyebrows), chest, and intertriginous areas. See Seborrheic Dermatitis.

### **Seckel Syndrome**

A rare recessive primordial dwarfism syndrome featuring severe proportionate growth restriction, microcephaly, characteristic facial features, and developmental or intellectual impairment. Skeletal, hematological, and other congenital abnormalities may occur.

### **Second Malignancy**

New cancer after initial cancer treatment. Risk from radiation, chemotherapy.

### **Second Messenger Systems**

Intracellular signaling molecules that relay extracellular signals (first messengers: hormones, neurotransmitters, growth factors) to cellular responses.

### **Second Messengers**

Intracellular signaling molecules generated in response to extracellular signals (first messengers like hormones or neurotransmitters). cAMP (cyclic adenosine monophosphate): produced from ATP by adenylyl cyclase, activated by Gs-protein coupled receptors, activates protein kinase A (PKA); degraded by phosphodiesterase.

### **Second Opinion**

An independent medical assessment by another qualified clinician to help confirm or clarify a diagnosis, prognosis, or treatment plan.

### **Second Stage Of Labor**

From full cervical dilatation (10 cm) to delivery of the baby. The mother feels the urge to push as the presenting part descends. Pushing: closed-glottis (Valsalva) or open-glottis. Duration: up to 3 hours in nulliparas with regional anesthesia (2 hours without), and 2 hours in multiparas (1 hour without).

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## Second Trimester

The period from 13 to 27 weeks gestational age. Fetal growth accelerates, mother begins to feel quickening (fetal movement) between 16-20 weeks. Anatomy ultrasound at 18-22 weeks screens for structural anomalies. Maternal serum screening offered. Nausea typically resolves.

## Second-Degree AV Block

Intermittent failure of AV conduction. Mobitz Type I (Wenckebach): progressive PR prolongation then dropped QRS; usually benign (AV nodal, narrow QRS). Mobitz Type II: constant PR interval with sudden dropped QRS; more serious (infranodal, wide QRS), risk of progression to complete heart block and Stokes-Adams attacks.

## Second-Degree Burn

Partial-thickness burn involving the epidermis and dermis: superficial partial-thickness (blisters, moist, painful, pink) vs. deep partial-thickness (blanching, painful, may have thrombosed capillaries). Causes: thermal (scalds, flames), chemical, electrical.

## Second-Hand Smoke

Smoke inhaled from burning tobacco products or exhaled by a person who is smoking. It contains toxic substances and increases health risks in exposed people.

## Secondary Attack Rate

The proportion of susceptible contacts who develop infection after exposure to a primary case within a defined period. It helps estimate transmissibility in households, schools, healthcare settings, and other close-contact groups.

## Secondary Hyperparathyroidism

Compensatory PTH increase in CKD from decreased phosphate excretion, low calcitriol, and hypocalcemia. Leads to renal osteodystrophy and vascular calcification. Managed with dietary phosphorus restriction, phosphate binders, active vitamin D, and calcimimetics. Refractory cases may require parathyroidectomy.

## Secondary Immune Response

The rapid, enhanced immune response on re-exposure to an antigen, mediated by memory B cells and memory T cells generated during the primary response. Features: shorter lag phase, higher and faster antibody titers (predominantly high-affinity IgG), and more effective cell-mediated responses.

## Secondary Immunodeficiency

Reduced immune function caused by an acquired condition or exposure rather than a primary genetic disorder. Causes include HIV infection, cancer, malnutrition, medicines, and chronic disease; the manifestations depend on which immune functions are impaired.

## Secondary Prevention

Early detection and treatment. Examples: screening (mammography, colonoscopy, blood pressure), self-examination.

## Secondary Syphilis

The systemic dissemination stage of *Treponema pallidum* infection, occurring weeks to months after the primary chancre, characterised by a generalised maculopapular rash (including the palms and soles), mucous patches, condylomata lata, lymphadenopathy, and systemic symptoms such as fever and malaise.

## Secondary Tumor

A tumor formed when cancer cells spread from the original site to another part of the body.

## Secretin

A peptide hormone produced by S-cells in the duodenal and jejunal mucosa in response to acidic chyme (pH less than 4.5) entering the duodenum from the stomach.

## Secretion

Active movement of a substance from cells into a body fluid, lumen, or external environment. In toxicokinetics, renal tubular or biliary secretion can contribute to elimination of a toxin or metabolite.

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## Secretory Diarrhea

Diarrhea caused by active secretion or reduced absorption of electrolytes and water by the intestine. It persists despite fasting and may result from infections, medications, bile-acid disorders, endocrine tumors, or inflammatory disease.

## Sedation Dentistry

Pharmacological techniques for anxiety management: nitrous oxide (laughing gas), oral sedation, IV sedation, general anesthesia. Indications: dental phobia, special needs, prolonged procedures. Monitoring required for deeper sedation.

## Sedation Levels

A continuum ranging from minimal sedation, in which normal responses to verbal commands are preserved, to moderate or deep sedation, in which responses and airway or breathing support may be reduced. The level can change and requires appropriate monitoring.

## Sedative

A medication that reduces central nervous system activity, producing calming effects, drowsiness, and sleep at higher doses. Sedatives are used for anxiety, procedural sedation, insomnia, and as adjuncts in anesthesia.

## Sedative-Hypnotic

CNS depressants. Benzodiazepines, barbiturates, Z-drugs. Overdose: respiratory depression, coma. Treatment: supportive, flumazenil (benzodiazepines only), airway management.

## Segmental Pressures

Blood pressure measurements at different leg levels. Localizes level of obstruction.

## Segmentation

A pattern of intestinal motility involving localized, rhythmic contractions of circular muscle that segment the intestinal contents, mixing them with digestive secretions and increasing contact with the absorptive mucosal surface. Unlike peristalsis, segmentation does not propel contents distally.

## Seizure

A transient occurrence of signs and/or symptoms due to abnormal, excessive, or synchronous neuronal activity in the brain. Provoked seizures have an identifiable acute cause (fever, electrolyte disturbance, drug toxicity, withdrawal). Unprovoked seizures occur without an acute trigger.

## Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulator

A class of medications that bind to estrogen receptors (ER-alpha and ER-beta) with tissue-specific agonist or antagonist activity, depending on the target tissue and differential co-regulator recruitment.

## Selective Mutism

Consistent failure to speak in specific social situations where speaking is expected despite speaking in other situations. The disturbance interferes with educational or occupational achievement or social communication. Must last for at least one month and is not attributable to lack of knowledge of or comfort with the spoken language.

## Selenium

Trace mineral, component of antioxidant enzymes. Deficiency: Keshan disease (cardiomyopathy), Kashin-Beck disease (osteoarthropathy). Sources: Brazil nuts, seafood, meat.

## Selenium-75

Calibration source. Half-life 119 days. Used for uniformity correction.

## Self-Efficacy

Patient belief in ability to manage condition. Influences adherence, outcomes.

## Self-Experimentation

Research in which an investigator deliberately uses an intervention or procedure on themselves. It requires careful attention to consent, safety, and scientific validity.

## Self-Harm

Intentional self-inflicted injury without suicidal in-

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tent, also termed non-suicidal self-injury; common methods include cutting, burning, and self-hitting. Prevalent in adolescents and in borderline personality disorder, depression, eating disorders, and trauma, serving affect regulation or self-punishment.

### **Self-Management**

Actions a person takes to monitor and manage a health condition, including treatment use, symptom monitoring, and lifestyle measures.

### **Semen**

The fluid ejaculated from the male reproductive tract, containing sperm (produced in the testes) suspended in seminal plasma (produced by the seminal vesicles, prostate, and bulbourethral glands). Semen provides nutrients (fructose, amino acids), protective agents (zinc, antioxidants), and a medium for sperm transport.

### **Semen Analysis**

Laboratory assessment of ejaculate volume, sperm concentration, total count, motility, morphology, vitality, and other characteristics. It is a key initial test in male-factor infertility and should usually be repeated because results vary biologically.

### **Semicircular Canals**

Three fluid-filled (endolymph) loops in each inner ear, oriented approximately orthogonally to detect angular (rotational) acceleration in three planes: horizontal (lateral), anterior (superior), and posterior. Each has an ampulla with a crista containing hair cells embedded in a gelatinous cupula.

### **Seminal Vesicle**

One of a paired set of male accessory reproductive glands behind the urinary bladder. Its fructose-rich secretion contributes substantially to semen and joins the vas deferens through the ejaculatory duct.

### **Sensorineural Hearing Loss**

Hearing loss from pathology of the cochlea or auditory (eighth cranial) nerve, characterized on pure-tone audiometry by elevated bone conduction thresholds and no air-bone gap.

### **Speech Audiometry**

Hearing testing that measures detection or recognition of speech at different loudness levels. It commonly includes speech reception threshold and word-recognition testing, complementing pure-tone audiometry.

#### **Synonyms:**

Speech testing; speech audiometric testing.

### **Sensorium**

The state or level of consciousness and awareness of one's surroundings.

### **Sensory Level**

A sharply demarcated horizontal boundary below which sensation is altered on the trunk or limbs. A sensory level strongly suggests a spinal-cord lesion, although its localization requires correlation with motor, reflex, and autonomic findings.

### **Sensory Nerves**

Nerves that transmit sensory information from peripheral receptors to the central nervous system. Sensory (afferent) neurons have their cell bodies in the dorsal root ganglia (spinal nerves) or cranial nerve ganglia (cranial nerves).

### **Sentinel Event**

Unexpected occurrence involving death or serious physical/psychological injury. Requires root cause analysis.

### **Sentinel Injury**

A minor but potentially significant injury in a non-mobile infant, such as unexplained bruising, oral injury, or a fracture, that may precede more severe abuse. It warrants careful history, complete examination, safeguarding assessment, and documentation.

### **Sentinel Lymph Node**

First lymph node draining tumor site. Biopsy assesses nodal spread.

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### Sentinel Lymph-Node Biopsy

Surgical removal and pathologic examination of the first draining lymph node or nodes from a primary skin cancer. It is used for selected melanomas and other tumors to assess regional metastatic risk and guide staging.

### Sentinel Surveillance

Ongoing collection of health data from selected reporting sites, providers, or populations chosen to represent trends rather than enumerate every event. It can provide early warning and monitor changes in disease activity.

### Separation Anxiety Disorder

Developmentally inappropriate and excessive fear or anxiety concerning separation from attachment figures. The individual may have recurrent excessive distress when anticipating or experiencing separation from home or major attachment figures.

### Separation Of The Iris

Disinsertion or dialysis of the iris root from its attachment at the ciliary body, typically caused by blunt ocular trauma. It appears as a peripheral iridodialysis visible on slit-lamp examination and may cause monocular double vision, glare, or secondary glaucoma if extensive.

### Sepsis Syndrome

The spectrum of the host's dysregulated response to infection: sepsis (infection + organ dysfunction, SOFA increase  $\geq 2$ ), septic shock (sepsis + hypotension requiring vasopressors with lactate  $>2$  mmol/L despite adequate fluid), and severe organ dysfunction/multi-organ failure.

### Septal Hematoma

Accumulation of blood between the perichondrium and the septal cartilage of the nose, typically following nasal trauma (nasal fracture). Presents with nasal obstruction, pain, and a bluish, boggy swelling of the nasal septum.

### Septic Embolism

Septic embolism occurs when infected material,

typically thrombi containing bacteria, embolizes through the bloodstream to distant sites, causing metastatic infection. The most common source is infective endocarditis, where infected vegetations on heart valves break off and lodge in peripheral vessels.

### Septicemia

Septicemia is an older term for serious bloodstream infection; modern assessment distinguishes bacteremia from sepsis, which is life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by infection.

### Septo-Optic Dysplasia

A congenital disorder characterized by variable combinations of optic-nerve hypoplasia, midline brain abnormalities, and pituitary hormone deficiencies. It may cause visual impairment, nystagmus, developmental differences, seizures, and growth or endocrine problems.

### Septoplasty

Septoplasty is surgery to straighten or reshape the nasal septum to improve airflow or address structural obstruction.

### Sequential Therapy

Treatments given in sequence. Used when combination not suitable.

### Serodiagnostic

Relating to diagnosis by detecting antibodies or other markers in blood serum.

### Serology

The laboratory evaluation of serum for antibodies, antigens, or other immune markers. Results may indicate current infection, previous exposure, vaccination, autoimmune reactivity, or passive antibody transfer and must be interpreted with timing and clinical context.

### Seronegative Arthritis

Arthritis with negative rheumatoid factor and anti-CCP. Includes spondyloarthropathies, psoriatic



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arthritis, reactive arthritis.

### Serotonin Syndrome

A potentially life-threatening condition caused by excessive serotonergic activity in the central and peripheral nervous systems, typically resulting from drug interactions or overdose involving serotonergic medications.

### Serotonin-Norepinephrine Reuptake Inhibitors

Antidepressants that block the reuptake of both serotonin and norepinephrine. They include venlafaxine, duloxetine, desvenlafaxine, and levomilnacipran. SNRIs are used for major depressive disorder, generalized anxiety disorder, diabetic neuropathy, fibromyalgia, and chronic pain.

### Serotonin-Norepinephrine-Dopamine Reuptake Inhibitors

A class of antidepressants that inhibit reuptake of serotonin, norepinephrine, and dopamine. The primary agent is bupropion, which also acts as a norepinephrine-dopamine reuptake inhibitor. It is used for depression, smoking cessation, and as augmentation. It lacks sexual side effects and weight gain associated with SSRIs.

### Serpentine Supravenous Hyperpigmentation

A dermatological finding characterized by dark, wavy, serpiginous hyperpigmentation along the course of superficial veins, most commonly on the upper chest and neck. Associated with venous stasis, thrombophlebitis, and certain malignancies. The pigmentation results from hemosiderin deposition in the perivenous dermis.

### Serrated Pathway

Alternative molecular pathway to colorectal carcinogenesis accounting for fifteen to thirty percent of cases. It involves serrated polyps as precursors including sessile serrated lesions with dysplasia. Molecular features include CpG island methylator phenotype, BRAF mutations, and microsatellite instability from MLH1 silencing.

### Serratus Anterior Muscle

Fan-shaped muscle from ribs 1-8/9 to the medial scapular border. Innervated by long thoracic nerve (C5-C7). Protracts scapula, upwardly rotates glenoid for overhead elevation, stabilizes against thorax. Long thoracic nerve injury causes medial scapular winging, especially visible during wall push-ups. Commonly injured in breast surgery.

### Sertoli-Cell Tumor

A sex-cord stromal tumor that may produce androgens or estrogens and can cause endocrine manifestations.

### Serum Concentration

The concentration of a substance measured in the liquid component of clotted blood. Interpretation depends on sampling time, exposure history, distribution, metabolism, elimination, and the relationship between concentration and toxicity.

### Serum Osmolal Gap

The difference between measured serum osmolality and calculated osmolality. An increased gap suggests unmeasured osmoles, including toxic alcohols, but interpretation must consider timing, renal function, lactate, ketones, and laboratory variation.

### Serum Protein Electrophoresis

Separation of serum proteins by electrophoresis into 5 fractions: albumin, alpha-1, alpha-2, beta, and gamma. Monoclonal gammopathy: M-spike in gamma region (multiple myeloma, MGUS, Waldenstrom macroglobulinemia). Immunofixation: identifies heavy chain (IgG, IgA, IgM, IgD, IgE) and light chain (kappa, lambda) isotype.

### Sever Disease

Calcaneal apophysitis in children/adolescents. Heel pain, worse with activity. Treatment: rest, heel cups, stretching.

### Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome

A severe respiratory illness caused by SARS coronavirus, characterized by fever, dry cough, dyspnea, and viral pneumonia that may progress to respira-



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tory failure.

### Severe Combined Immunodeficiency

Severe combined immunodeficiency (SCID) represents a group of genetic disorders characterized by profoundly defective T cell development and function, with variable B and NK cell involvement, resulting in severe susceptibility to life-threatening infections in infancy.

### Sevoflurane

A volatile inhaled anesthetic with relatively low blood-gas solubility, permitting rapid changes in anesthetic depth and recovery. It can cause dose-dependent cardiovascular and respiratory depression and is a recognized trigger of malignant hyperthermia in susceptible patients.

### Sexual Assault

A broad legal category of any non-consensual sexual contact or penetration, encompassing rape, indecent assault, and drug-facilitated assault. Examination documents general and anogenital injuries, collects biological and trace samples, and screens for drug-facilitated assault by extended-window testing.

#### Synonyms:

Rape (Sexual Assault)

### Sexual Intercourse (Coitus)

The insertion of a penis into a partner's body for sexual pleasure, reproduction, or both. Most commonly vaginal intercourse (penile-vaginal penetration) but may also include anal intercourse. Sexual intercourse is a key component of human pair bonding and reproduction.

#### Synonyms:

Coitus

### Sexual Masochism Disorder

A paraphilic disorder characterized by recurrent, intense sexual arousal from the act of being humiliated, beaten, bound, or otherwise made to suffer, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing distress or impairment or involving acting on these urges.

### Sexual Rehabilitation

Address sexual function after injury, illness. Counseling, devices, medications.

### Sexual Sadism Disorder

A paraphilic disorder characterized by recurrent, intense sexual arousal from the physical or psychological suffering of another person, lasting  $\geq 6$  months and causing distress or impairment or involving acting on these urges with a nonconsenting person.

### Sexually Transmitted Infection

STI: infection transmitted via sexual contact. Examples: syphilis, gonorrhea, chlamydia, HIV.

### SGLT2 Inhibitor

A drug that reduces sodium-glucose cotransport in the proximal renal tubule, increasing urinary glucose and sodium excretion.

### Shadowing Artifact

Ultrasound artifact from attenuating structures. Enhanced by harmonic imaging.

### Shaken Baby Syndrome

A form of abusive head trauma caused by violent shaking, typically in infants under 1 year. The triad: subdural hemorrhage, retinal hemorrhages, and encephalopathy. May present with irritability, lethargy, vomiting, seizures, and apnea. CT shows subdural hematoma; MRI shows diffuse axonal injury.

### Shared Decision-Making

A collaborative process in which clinicians and patients combine best available evidence with patient values, preferences, goals, and circumstances to choose among reasonable options.

### Sharp Force Trauma

Injury produced by an edged or pointed instrument that cuts or penetrates the skin, divided into incised wounds (longer than deep, clean margins) and stab wounds (deeper than wide). Wound length, depth,

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angle, hesitation marks, and defense injuries infer weapon type and manner.

### **Sharps Container**

Puncture-resistant container for used needles and sharp instruments. Red, labeled biohazard.

### **Sharps Injury**

A percutaneous or mucocutaneous injury caused by a needle or other sharp instrument that may expose a person to blood or body fluids. Immediate wound care, incident reporting, risk assessment, and pathogen-specific post-exposure management are required.

### **Shave Biopsy**

Removal of a raised skin lesion by horizontal slicing with a scalpel at the level of the dermis; used for exophytic lesions such as seborrheic keratoses and superficial basal cell carcinomas.

### **Sheehan Syndrome**

Postpartum pituitary necrosis resulting from severe hemorrhage and hypotension during delivery. The pituitary gland is enlarged during pregnancy and particularly vulnerable to ischemic injury from blood loss. Presentation varies from fatigue and failure to lactate to panhypopituitarism. Growth hormone and prolactin deficiency occur first.

### **Sheehan Syndrome (Postpartum Pituitary Necrosis)**

Ischemic necrosis of the anterior pituitary gland due to severe postpartum hemorrhage (PPH) and hypotension. The pituitary enlarges during pregnancy and is vulnerable to ischemia from hypotensive episodes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Postpartum Pituitary Necrosis

### **Shielding**

Lead, tungsten, acrylic shielding for radiation protection.

### **Shigellosis**

Shigellosis is intestinal infection caused by *Shigella* bacteria, producing diarrhea that may be bloody, fever, cramps, and dehydration.

### **Shirodkar Cerclage**

A transvaginal cervical cerclage technique that involves dissection of the bladder and rectum to place the suture (Mersilene tape) as high as possible at the level of the internal os. Technically more difficult than McDonald cerclage with higher risk of hemorrhage and bladder injury.

### **Shivering**

Involuntary, rhythmic skeletal muscle contraction generating heat in response to cold exposure or fever, a key thermoregulatory response under hypothalamic (preoptic area) control. Shivering can increase heat production 3-5 fold.

### **Shock Wave Lithotripsy**

Non-invasive procedure using extracorporeal shock waves to fragment renal and ureteral stones. The patient is positioned over a water cushion coupling the shock wave generator to the body. Shock waves are focused on the stone under fluoroscopic or ultrasound guidance.

### **Shone Complex**

A group of congenital left-sided obstructive heart lesions, classically including supravulvular mitral ring, parachute mitral valve, subaortic stenosis, and coarctation of the aorta. The combination and severity vary and may lead to heart failure or systemic outflow obstruction.

### **Short Bowel Syndrome**

Clinical condition resulting from surgical resection or functional loss of a significant portion of the small intestine leading to inadequate absorption of nutrients.

### **Shortness Of Breath**

An uncomfortable awareness of difficult or insufficient breathing. See Dyspnea.

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## Shoulder Dislocation

Complete displacement of the upper arm bone from the shoulder socket, usually caused by a fall, collision, or forceful twisting. It causes severe pain, deformity, and inability to move the arm; urgent reduction and assessment for associated fractures or nerve and blood-vessel injury are required.

## Shoulder Dystocia

An obstetric emergency where the fetal head delivers but the anterior shoulder is impacted behind the maternal symphysis pubis. Defined as head-to-body delivery time exceeding 60 seconds or need for ancillary maneuvers. Risk factors include macrosomia, diabetes, prior shoulder dystocia, and operative vaginal delivery.

## Shoulder Impingement

Pain associated with movement of the shoulder, often involving the rotator-cuff tendons or subacromial tissues. Symptoms include pain with overhead activity and sometimes weakness; assessment and treatment are individualized and may include exercise-based rehabilitation.

## Shoulder Instability

Excessive or recurrent movement of the shoulder joint caused by injury, laxity, or altered joint anatomy. Associated lesions may include a Bankart tear, Hill-Sachs lesion, or injury to the joint capsule or ligaments.

## Shoulder Pain

Pain in or around the shoulder caused by injury, tendon or bursa disorders, arthritis, nerve disease, or referred pain. Sudden weakness, deformity, chest symptoms, fever, or pain after major trauma requires prompt evaluation.

## Shunt (Vascular)

A surgically created or implanted pathway that redirects blood or another fluid from one vessel or body space to another.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Shwachman Syndrome

An inherited multisystem disorder usually involving exocrine pancreatic insufficiency, bone-marrow dysfunction, and skeletal abnormalities. Children may have steatorrhea, poor growth, recurrent infections, neutropenia, anemia, or increased risk of myeloid malignancy.

## SIADH

Syndrome of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone secretion characterized by hyponatremia (dilutional) with inappropriately concentrated urine ( $>100$  mOsm/kg) and elevated urine sodium ( $>40$  mEq/L). Euvolemic hyponatremia.

## SIADH (Syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion)

Excessive vasopressin activity causing impaired free-water excretion, euvolemic hyponatremia, and inappropriately concentrated urine after exclusion of other causes. Treatment depends on severity and cause and may include fluid restriction or carefully monitored hypertonic saline for severe symptomatic cases.

### Synonyms:

Syndrome of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion

## Sialadenitis

Inflammation of salivary gland. Acute (bacterial) or chronic (recurrent). Treatment: antibiotics, hydration, gland massage, surgery if chronic.

## Sialography

Contrast imaging of salivary ducts. Evaluates obstruction, stricture, tumors. Rarely performed now.

## Sialolithiasis

Formation of a stone in a salivary gland or its duct, most often the submandibular gland. It may cause recurrent swelling and pain, especially during meals, and can lead to infection or obstruction.

## Sialorrhea

Excessive salivation. Neurological causes, medica-

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tions, dental causes. Treatment: hydration, glycopyrrolate, botulinum toxin, surgery.

### Sialuria

A rare inherited disorder of sialic-acid metabolism caused by abnormal regulation of the GNE enzyme. Excess free sialic acid accumulates in cells and urine and may cause developmental delay, coarse facial features, hepatosplenomegaly, and variable intellectual disability.

### Sicca Syndrome

Dry eyes and dry mouth due to decreased tear and saliva production. Primary: Sjogren syndrome. Secondary: associated with RA, SLE, scleroderma, graft-versus-host disease, hepatitis C, sarcoidosis, HIV, medications (anticholinergics, antidepressants). Diagnosis: Schirmer test (<5 mm/5 min), rose bengal staining, salivary gland biopsy.

### Sick Sinus Syndrome

Sinus node dysfunction causing a spectrum of arrhythmias: sinus bradycardia, sinus arrest, sinoatrial block, and tachycardia-bradycardia syndrome. Most common in elderly patients. Presents with syncope, fatigue, palpitations, and exercise intolerance. Diagnosis: ECG, Holter monitor (pauses >3 seconds).

#### Synonyms:

Bradycardia-Tachycardia Syndrome

### Sickle Cell Anemia

The most severe form of sickle cell disease (HbSS), causing chronic hemolytic anemia and vaso-occlusive crises. Features: jaundice, splenomegaly (infancy), pain crises, acute chest syndrome, stroke, and increased infection risk from functional asplenia. Diagnosis: hemoglobin electrophoresis showing HbS.

### Sickle Cell Crisis

An acute clinical complication of sickle cell disease, most commonly a vaso-occlusive episode producing ischemic pain. Other acute crises include acute chest syndrome, splenic or hepatic sequestration, and aplastic crisis; treatment depends on the specific complication and severity.

### Sickle Cell Dactylitis

Painful swelling of the hands or feet caused by blockage of small blood vessels during a sickle-cell episode, especially in infants and young children. It may be an early sign of sickle-cell disease and requires appropriate clinical evaluation.

### Sickle Cell Disease

Autosomal recessive hemoglobinopathy (HbS). Glutamic acid → valine at position 6 of beta-globin. Homozygous (HbSS) most severe. Sickling under hypoxia causes vaso-occlusion, hemolysis. Symptoms: pain crises, acute chest syndrome, stroke, splenic sequestration, aplastic crisis (parvovirus B19).

### Sickle Cell Trait

An inherited carrier state in which a person has one hemoglobin S allele and one normal beta-globin allele, usually producing both hemoglobin A and hemoglobin S. Most people are asymptomatic, but complications can occur in severe physiologic conditions.

### Side Effect

An unintended pharmacological effect of a drug occurring at therapeutic doses, usually predictable from the drug's mechanism of action (a Type A reaction).

### Sievert (Sv)

The SI unit used for equivalent and effective dose, incorporating radiation type and, for effective dose, tissue sensitivity. It is used to estimate stochastic radiation risk rather than simply physical energy deposition.

#### Synonyms:

Sv

### Sigmoid Colon

S-shaped segment from descending colon to rectum in the left iliac fossa, approximately 40-50 cm, with complete mesentery (intraperitoneal, mobile). Most common diverticular disease site from narrow lumen and high pressure. Common volvulus site, particularly in elderly/institutionalized patients. Second most common colorectal cancer site.

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## Sigmoid Volvulus

Axial twisting of the sigmoid colon around its mesentery, the most common cause of colonic volvulus, typically occurring in elderly, institutionalized, or neuropsychiatric patients with chronic constipation and a redundant sigmoid. Presents with acute large bowel obstruction, abdominal distension, and absent bowel sounds.

## Sign

Objective evidence of disease. Examples: rash, murmur, edema. Observed by examiner.

## Signal Transduction

The process by which an extracellular signal (hormone, neurotransmitter, growth factor, drug) binding to a cell-surface or intracellular receptor is converted into a specific intracellular response.

## Signal-To-Noise Ratio

Ratio of true counts to statistical noise. Improved by longer acquisition, higher activity.

## Signet Ring Cell Carcinoma

A poorly differentiated adenocarcinoma in which intracellular mucin displaces the nucleus to the periphery, most often of the stomach or colon; associated with an aggressive course and diffuse growth pattern.

## Silicone Oil Hyperoleon

Emulsification of silicone oil tamponade used in vitreoretinal surgery, where the oil breaks into tiny droplets that migrate into the anterior chamber or trabecular meshwork. It can cause elevated intraocular pressure, band keratopathy, and chronic inflammation requiring oil removal and anterior chamber washout.

## Silver Diamine Fluoride

Liquid that arrests caries and stains cavity black. Used in young children, special needs patients.

## Sinding-Larsen-Johansson Syndrome

Traction apophysitis of inferior patellar pole in ado-

lescents. Similar to Osgood-Schlatter but at knee. Treatment: rest, activity modification.

## Single Nucleotide Polymorphism

Single base pair variation occurring in >1% of population. Most common genetic variation. Used in GWAS, forensics, pharmacogenetics.

## Single Photon Emission Computed Tomography

Nuclear medicine imaging using gamma-emitting isotopes (technetium-99m most common). Rotating gamma camera acquires images. Applications: myocardial perfusion, bone scans, thyroid imaging, renal scans, brain perfusion. Lower resolution than PET but more widely available and cost-effective.

## Single Ventricle

A group of congenital heart defects where one functional ventricle supports both the systemic and pulmonary circulations. Includes tricuspid atresia, mitral atresia, double inlet left ventricle, hypoplastic left heart syndrome, and unbalanced AV canal.

## Single-Dose Toxicity

Harm caused by one exposure to a substance or medicine, assessed according to dose, route, timing, and the exposed person's characteristics.

## Sinus Lift

Procedure to increase bone height in posterior maxilla. Subperiosteal or transalveolar approach. Graft material placed.

## Sinus Pain

Pressure or pain around the forehead, cheeks, nose, or eyes caused by sinus inflammation, infection, migraine, or other conditions. Severe headache, eye swelling, vision change, high fever, or neurologic symptoms requires urgent assessment.

## Sinus Rhomboidalis

A diamond-shaped depression in the floor of the fourth ventricle of the brain.



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## Sinuses

Air-filled cavities within the skull bones lined by respiratory mucosa, connected to the nasal cavity via ostia.

## Sinusitis And Sinus Problems

Inflammation or infection of the paranasal sinuses that may cause nasal congestion, discharge, facial pressure, headache, or reduced smell. Symptoms may also arise from other nasal or facial conditions and require assessment when persistent or severe.

## Sinusoidal Fetal Heart Rate Pattern

A rare, ominous FHR pattern characterized by a smooth, sine-wave-like undulation with a fixed frequency (2-5 cycles/minute) and absent variability. Strongly associated with severe fetal anemia (Rh isoimmunization, fetomaternal hemorrhage, parvovirus B19), fetal hypoxia, and fetal acidosis.

## Sirenomelia

A rare congenital malformation in which the lower limbs are partially or completely fused. It is usually associated with severe abnormalities of the genitourinary, gastrointestinal, vascular, and spinal systems and is often fatal in the neonatal period.

## Sister Mary Joseph's Nodule

A firm, hard nodule in the umbilicus resulting from metastatic malignancy, most commonly from intra-abdominal or pelvic cancers including gastric, ovarian, and colorectal carcinoma. It indicates advanced, disseminated disease with a poor prognosis. Diagnosis is by fine needle aspiration biopsy.

## Sitosterolemia

An autosomal-recessive disorder of plant-sterol transport caused by ABCG5 or ABCG8 variants. It can produce premature atherosclerosis, xanthomas, hemolytic anemia, macrothrombocytopenia, and elevated plasma plant sterols.

## Situs Inversus

A congenital condition in which the thoracic and abdominal organs are reversed or mirrored from their normal positions. Complete situs inversus

(situs inversus totalis) involves all organs.

## Situs Inversus Totalis

A congenital condition in which the major visceral organs are mirrored from their normal positions, with the liver on the left, heart on the right, and other viscera similarly reversed.

## Sjogren Syndrome

Primary Sjogren syndrome (pSS) is a chronic autoimmune exocrinopathy characterized by lymphocytic infiltration of lacrimal and salivary glands causing dry eyes (keratoconjunctivitis sicca) and dry mouth (xerostomia), with female predominance (9:1) and peak onset 40-60. Secondary SS occurs with RA, SLE, SSc.

## SjöGren Syndrome

A systemic autoimmune disease characterized by lymphocytic destruction and dysfunction of lacrimal and salivary glands, producing dry eyes and dry mouth. It may involve multiple organs and increases the risk of salivary-gland lymphoma.

## Skeletal Muscle Relaxant

A medication that reduces muscle spasm, spasticity, and associated pain.

## Skeletal Survey

A series of radiographs obtained when child abuse is suspected. Includes AP and lateral views of the skull, chest (including oblique views), abdomen, spine, and bilateral upper and lower extremities. Identifies fractures of varying ages, which is highly suggestive of non-accidental trauma.

## Skeletonization

Final stage of postmortem decomposition where soft tissues, organs, and skin have completely decayed or been scavenged, leaving only clean osseous skeletal remains.

## Skilled Nursing Facility

Inpatient facility providing skilled nursing and therapy. For recovery after hospitalization.



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## Skin Absorption

Movement of a substance through the skin into underlying tissues or the bloodstream. Absorption depends on the substance, skin condition, contact time, and exposed area.

## Skin Aging

Skin aging has intrinsic (chronological) and extrinsic (photoaging) components. Photoaging causes wrinkle formation, telangiectasias, lentigines, leather-like texture, and actinic keratoses. Intrinsic aging causes thinning, wrinkling, and delayed wound healing. Prevention includes sun protection (broad-spectrum SPF 30 or greater daily).

## Skin Aging And Appearance

Skin aging is a complex biological process influenced by both intrinsic factors, such as genetics and natural aging, and extrinsic factors, particularly ultraviolet radiation exposure.

## Skin Allergies And Contact Dermatitis

Inflammatory skin reactions triggered by exposure to allergens or irritants that come into direct contact with the skin.

## Skin Allergy Testing

Skin allergy testing includes prick testing (immediate hypersensitivity, IgE-mediated) and intradermal testing (more sensitive, used for drug and venom allergy). Prick testing introduces allergen extract into the epidermis; wheal and flare reaction at 15 minutes indicates sensitization. Intradermal testing injects dilute allergen into the dermis.

## Skin And Aging

Skin aging involves intrinsic and extrinsic changes. Intrinsic aging causes thinning, wrinkling, and fragility. Extrinsic (photo)aging causes wrinkles, telangiectasias, lentigines, and actinic keratoses. Collagen loss, elastin degradation, and decreased cell turnover contribute to aging skin.

## Skin And Environment

Environmental factors significantly affect skin health. Pollution causes oxidative stress, inflam-

mation, and accelerated aging. Particulate matter penetrates skin, generating free radicals. Blue light from screens causes hyperpigmentation, particularly in darker skin tones. Indoor heating and air conditioning cause dryness.

## Skin Appendages

Skin structures include hair follicles, sebaceous glands, eccrine sweat glands, and apocrine sweat glands. Hair follicles cycle through anagen (growth), catagen (transition), and telogen (resting) phases. Sebaceous glands produce sebum, an oily substance lubricating skin and hair.

## Skin Barrier Function

The skin barrier prevents water loss and protects against environmental insults. The stratum corneum acts as a physical barrier, while the acid mantle (pH 4 to 6) provides chemical defense. Lipids (ceramides, cholesterol, free fatty acids) in the intercellular space form a waterproof barrier.

## Skin Biopsy Methods

Skin biopsy methods vary by lesion characteristics. Punch biopsy (2 to 6 mm circular blade) provides full-thickness specimen for most diagnoses. Shave biopsy (razor or scalpel) removes superficial lesions; deep shave (saucerization) includes subcutaneous fat for suspected melanoma.

## Skin Biopsy Techniques

Skin biopsy is selected according to the suspected diagnosis and lesion depth. Punch biopsy samples full-thickness skin; shave biopsy samples superficial lesions; excisional biopsy removes an entire small lesion; and incisional biopsy samples part of a large lesion.

## Skin Cancer

Most common cancer. Types: basal cell, squamous cell, melanoma. Prevention: sun protection. Early detection critical.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Skin

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## Skin Cancer Epidemiology

Skin cancers are common and include basal-cell carcinoma, squamous-cell carcinoma, and melanoma. Incidence and mortality vary by tumor type, geography, skin phenotype, ultraviolet exposure, immune status, and access to diagnosis and treatment.

## Skin Cancer Prevention

Prevention focuses on reducing ultraviolet exposure through shade, protective clothing, hats, sunglasses, and appropriately used broad-spectrum sunscreen. Avoiding tanning beds also reduces ultraviolet exposure.

## Skin Cancer Screening

Skin cancer screening uses the ABCDE criteria for melanoma, the ugly duckling sign, and total body skin examination. Dermoscopy (dermatoscopy) magnifies skin lesions revealing structures invisible to the naked eye, improving diagnostic accuracy. Skin self-examination teaches patients to monitor moles for changes.

## Skin Cancer Staging

Skin cancer staging guides treatment and prognosis. Melanoma: Breslow thickness (most important prognostic factor), ulceration, mitotic rate, sentinel lymph node status (AJCC 8th edition).

## Skin Cancer Surgery

Skin cancer surgical techniques maximize cure while minimizing morbidity. Wide local excision with appropriate margins (BCC: 4 mm, SCC: 4 to 6 mm, melanoma: based on Breslow thickness). Mohs micrographic surgery provides 99 percent cure rate for BCC and 97 percent for SCC with tissue preservation.

## Skin Flaps

Skin flaps transfer tissue with its blood supply. Rotation flaps rotate adjacent tissue into defect. Advancement flaps slide tissue forward. Transposition flaps move tissue across intervening skin. Random pattern flaps rely on dermal plexus; axial pattern flaps have named vascular pedicle.

## Skin Graft

Transfer of skin from a donor site to a recipient site to cover a wound. Split-thickness skin graft (STSG): epidermis + partial dermis (0.008-0.018 inches), harvested with dermatome, donor site heals spontaneously (2-3 weeks). Full-thickness skin graft (FTSG): epidermis + full dermis, donor site requires closure, better cosmetic outcome.

## Skin Immune System

The skin immune system (SALT: skin-associated lymphoid tissue) provides immunological surveillance. Langerhans cells (dendritic cells in epidermis) capture antigens and present them to T cells. Dermal dendritic cells, mast cells, and resident T cells form an innate and adaptive immune network.

## Skin Infection

Infection of the skin or underlying soft tissue, commonly caused by bacteria, fungi, or viruses. Redness, warmth, swelling, pain, drainage, or fever may occur; rapidly spreading redness, severe pain, blisters, or systemic illness requires prompt medical assessment.

## Skin Integrity

Localized damage to the skin and/or underlying soft tissue caused by prolonged pressure, shear, or friction, most commonly over bony prominences. See pressure injury.

## Skin Irritation

Inflammation or discomfort caused by direct contact with an irritant, often producing redness, burning, itching, dryness, or scaling.

## Skin Microbiome

The skin microbiome is the community of microorganisms (bacteria, fungi, viruses) residing on the skin. *Staphylococcus aureus* colonization is increased in atopic dermatitis and psoriasis. *Cutibacterium acnes* plays a role in acne. Diversity is decreased in diseased skin.

## Skin Of Color

Skin of color (Fitzpatrick IV to VI) has unique der-

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matologic considerations. It is more prone to hyperpigmentation disorders (post-inflammatory hyperpigmentation, melasma, acanthosis nigricans) and keloid formation. It is less prone to skin cancer but presents with more advanced disease when it occurs.

### **Skin Pigmentation**

Determined by melanin produced by melanocytes in the stratum basale. Eumelanin (brown-black) and pheomelanin (red-yellow) are the two types. Melanin production is stimulated by UV radiation through melanocyte-stimulating hormone (MSH). Fitzpatrick skin type classification (I to VI) describes pigmentation and sun response.

### **Skin Tags**

Benign fibroepithelial polyps occurring in intertriginous areas (neck, axillae, groin, under breasts). They are associated with obesity, insulin resistance, and pregnancy. Skin tags are asymptomatic but may become irritated or bleed. Treatment includes snipping, cryotherapy, electrocautery, and shave excision.

### **Skull Fracture**

Skull fracture examines skull fracture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. linear, depressed, basilar, or comminuted, with potential for intracranial injury and cerebrospinal fluid leak.

### **SLAP Lesion**

Superior labrum anterior to posterior tear. Associated with overhead activities, trauma. Treatment: rest, physical therapy, surgical repair if symptomatic.

### **SLAP Tears**

Tears of the superior glenoid labrum extending from anterior to posterior, sometimes involving the biceps tendon attachment. They may cause pain, clicking, or instability, especially with overhead activity.

### **Sleep (Geriatric)**

Sleep patterns and sleep problems in older adults,

including insomnia, sleep apnea, circadian changes, and medication-related disturbances.

#### **Synonyms:**

Geriatric

### **Sleep Apnea**

Repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep. It may be obstructive, central, or mixed and can disturb sleep and oxygenation.

### **Sleep Apnea (Dental)**

Oral appliance for obstructive sleep apnea. Mandibular advancement device. Indications: mild to moderate OSA, CPAP intolerance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Sleep Apnea (Obstructive Sleep Apnea - OSA)**

A sleep disorder characterized by repeated episodes of partial or complete upper airway obstruction during sleep (obstructive sleep apnea—OSA, most common) or cessation of respiratory drive (central sleep apnea—CSA), causing intermittent hypoxia, hypercapnia, and sleep fragmentation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Obstructive Sleep Apnea - OSA

### **Sleep Bruxism**

Repeated grinding or clenching of the teeth during sleep, which may cause tooth wear, jaw pain, or headaches.

### **Sleep Hygiene**

A set of behavioral and environmental practices designed to promote consistent, uninterrupted, and restorative sleep. Key elements include maintaining a regular sleep schedule, creating a cool, dark, and quiet sleep environment, avoiding caffeine and electronic screens before bedtime, and engaging in relaxing pre-sleep routines.

### **Sleep Medications And Supplements**

Pharmacological agents used to treat insomnia and other sleep disorders when behavioral interventions

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alone are insufficient.

### **Sleep Paralysis**

Temporary inability to move or speak when falling asleep or waking, while awareness is partly or fully preserved. Episodes usually last seconds to minutes and may include frightening hallucinations. Recurrent episodes can be associated with sleep deprivation, irregular sleep, narcolepsy, or other sleep disorders.

### **Sleep Studies (Polysomnography)**

Sleep tests, most commonly polysomnography, are diagnostic studies used to evaluate sleep architecture and identify sleep disorders. Polysomnography records brain waves, eye movements, heart rate, breathing patterns, blood oxygen levels, and limb movements throughout the night in a controlled laboratory setting.

#### **Synonyms:**

Polysomnography

### **Sleep-Related Hypoventilation**

Inadequate ventilation during sleep causing elevated carbon dioxide, oxygen desaturation, or both. Causes include obesity, neuromuscular disease, chest-wall disorders, chronic lung disease, medications, and central respiratory-control abnormalities.

### **Sleepwalking**

Sleepwalking addresses care related to sleepwalking, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician. sleep, usually with little or no memory afterward. It is more common in children and may be triggered by sleep deprivation, stress, fever, or other sleep disorders; injury prevention and evaluation of recurrent or dangerous episodes are important.

### **Sleeve Gastrectomy**

Removal of major stomach, leaving sleeve. Restrictive procedure. Lower malabsorption risk than bypass. Effective weight loss.

### **Sliding Filament**

The mechanism of muscle contraction in which actin filaments slide past myosin filaments, shortening the sarcomere without changing filament lengths. Myosin cross-bridges bind actin, undergo a power stroke using ATP hydrolysis, detach, and reattach to new actin sites in a cyclic manner.

### **Slipped Capital Femoral Epiphysis**

Displacement of the femoral head relative to the femoral neck through the growth plate (physis) in adolescents. Most common hip disorder in adolescents (10-16 years). Risk factors: obesity, male sex, African American, and endocrine disorders (hypothyroidism, growth hormone deficiency).

### **Slit Lamp Biomicroscopy**

A fundamental ophthalmological examination technique that uses a high-intensity, adjustable slit beam of light combined with a binocular microscope to provide a magnified, stereoscopic view of the anterior segment and, with the use of auxiliary lenses, the posterior segment of the eye.

### **Small Airway Disease**

Disease affecting airways with diameter  $< 2$  mm (bronchioles). It is the earliest site of damage in COPD and is often subclinical until advanced. It is characterized by narrowing, mucus plugging, and inflammation of small airways. PFTs may show air trapping (increased RV/TLC) before FEV1 decline.

### **Small Bowel Follow-Through**

Extended upper GI series tracking barium through small bowel.

### **Small Bowel Obstruction**

Partial or complete blockage of the small intestine. Common causes include adhesions, hernias, tumors, and inflammatory narrowing. Symptoms may include abdominal pain, vomiting, distension, and inability to pass stool or gas.

### **Small Bowel Series**

X-ray imaging of small intestine using barium. Evaluates Crohn disease, tumors, obstructions.

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### **Small Cell Carcinoma**

A high-grade neuroendocrine carcinoma, most often of the lung, strongly associated with smoking. Highly responsive initially to chemotherapy and radiation but prone to rapid recurrence and early brain metastases.

### **Small Cell Lung Cancer**

Aggressive lung cancer, strongly associated with smoking. Early metastasis, responds to chemotherapy.

### **Small Fiber Neuropathy**

Damage to small sensory and autonomic nerve fibers, often causing burning pain, tingling, altered temperature or pain sensation, abnormal sweating, or gastrointestinal and cardiovascular symptoms. Diabetes, autoimmune disease, vitamin deficiency, toxins, and inherited disorders may contribute; evaluation seeks an underlying cause.

### **Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth**

An abnormal increase or change in bacteria within the small intestine, often causing bloating, abdominal pain, nausea, diarrhea, fullness, weight loss, or nutrient deficiency. Causes include impaired intestinal movement, structural problems, surgery, and some systemic diseases; persistent symptoms require medical evaluation.

### **Small Intestine**

Longest GI segment (approximately 6 meters) from pylorus to ileocecal valve. Primary nutrient digestion and absorption site. Three segments: duodenum (25 cm, chyme/bile/pancreatic enzymes), jejunum (2.5 m, prominent folds/villi for absorption), ileum (3.5 m, Peyer's patches for immunity).

### **Small-Bowel Volvulus**

Twisting of the small intestine around its mesentery, causing mechanical obstruction and potentially compromising mesenteric blood flow. It may be primary (idiopathic, more common in developing countries) or secondary to adhesions, malrotation, hernias, or intraluminal tumors.

### **SMART Goals For Antibiotic Stewardship**

Stewardship objectives that are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-limited. They define a clear antimicrobial-use or patient-outcome target and a way to monitor progress.

### **SMILE**

Small incision lenticule extraction, commonly known as SMILE, is a minimally invasive refractive surgical procedure that corrects myopia and myopic astigmatism by creating and removing a thin, disc-shaped piece of corneal stroma called a lenticule through a small incision, without creating a corneal flap.

### **Smile Design**

Planning smile based on facial features, gum display, tooth proportions. Digital smile design software available.

### **Smith-Lemli-Opitz Syndrome**

An autosomal recessive disorder of cholesterol metabolism caused by mutations in DHCR7, encoding 7-dehydrocholesterol reductase, the final enzyme in the cholesterol biosynthetic pathway.

### **Smith-Magenis Syndrome**

A genetic neurodevelopmental disorder, usually involving deletion of 17p11.2 or an RAI1 variant. It causes developmental delay, intellectual disability, distinctive facial features, sleep disturbance, behavioral dysregulation, and variable congenital abnormalities.

### **Smoke Evacuator**

A device that captures and filters airborne surgical plume generated by electrosurgery, laser use, or ultrasonic energy. Evacuation reduces exposure to particulate matter, toxic gases, and potentially infectious biologic material.

### **Smoke Inhalation Injury**

Pulmonary injury caused by inhalation of toxic products of combustion.



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## Smoking Cessation

The process of stopping tobacco or nicotine use. It may involve counseling, behavioral support, medicines, or nicotine replacement.

## Smothering

Mechanical obstruction of the external nose and mouth that prevents effective ventilation. It may be caused by a covering, compression, or an obstructing soft material; findings are often nonspecific and must be interpreted with the scene, history, and complete examination.

## Snapping Hip Syndrome

Hip pain/clicking from tendon snapping over bony prominence. Internal (iliopsoas), external (IT band), intra-articular (labral tear). Treatment: physical therapy, injection, surgery if refractory.

## Sneddon Syndrome

A non-inflammatory thrombotic vasculopathy characterized by livedo racemosa and recurrent ischemic cerebrovascular events. Headache, hypertension, cognitive impairment, and cardiac-valve abnormalities may occur; evaluation addresses vascular risk and autoimmune or thrombophilic causes.

## Snoring And Sleep Apnea

Snoring is the sound produced by vibrating soft tissues in the upper airway during sleep, often resulting from partial airway obstruction. Sleep apnea is a more serious condition characterized by repeated episodes of complete or partial airway collapse during sleep, leading to intermittent hypoxia, frequent arousal, and fragmented sleep.

## SNRIs

Serotonin-norepinephrine reuptake inhibitors are a class of antidepressant drugs that inhibit the reuptake of both serotonin and norepinephrine from the synaptic cleft, increasing both serotonergic and noradrenergic neurotransmission. Common SNRIs include venlafaxine, duloxetine, desvenlafaxine, and levomilnacipran.

## Social Anxiety Disorder

Marked fear or anxiety about one or more social situations in which the individual may be scrutinized by others. The individual fears acting in a way or showing anxiety symptoms that will be negatively evaluated.

## Social Isolation

Limited contact or interaction with other people. Persistent isolation may adversely affect mental and physical health.

## Sodium Bicarbonate Therapy

Alkalinizing agent for metabolic acidosis in CKD. Target serum bicarbonate greater than 22 mEq/L. Slows CKD progression and improves muscle wasting. Dose titrated to serum levels.

## Sodium Polystyrene Sulfonate

Potassium-binding resin for hyperkalemia. Risk: colonic necrosis, especially with sorbitol.

## Soft Markers For Aneuploidy

Sonographic findings in the second trimester that are common in normal fetuses but have a statistically higher prevalence in aneuploid fetuses (especially trisomy 21).

## Soft Tissue Injury

Damage to muscles, tendons, ligaments, fascia, skin, or other non-bony tissues, often caused by trauma or overuse.

## Soft Tissue Rheumatism

Pain conditions affecting muscles, tendons, ligaments, bursae. Examples: frozen shoulder, lateral epicondylitis, rotator cuff tendinopathy. Treatment: rest, physiotherapy, injections, surgery if refractory.

## Soft Tissue Sarcoma

A group of malignant tumors arising in muscle, fat, fibrous tissue, blood vessels, or other connective tissues. Treatment depends on the subtype, location, stage, and relationship to nearby structures.

**Synonyms:**



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Cancer, Soft Tissue Sarcoma Sarcoma, Soft Tissue

### **Soft Tissue Tumors**

Lipoma: most common benign soft tissue tumor, subcutaneous, encapsulated. Liposarcoma: most common malignant STS in adults, deep, subtypes (well-differentiated/dedifferentiated, myxoid/round cell, pleomorphic). Synovial sarcoma: t(X;18), SS18-SSX, young adults, deep extremity, "triple sign" on MRI.

### **Soft-Tissue Calcinosis**

The deposition of insoluble calcium phosphate salts in soft tissues such as skin, subcutaneous tissue, muscles, and tendons, which may be metastatic (due to hypercalcaemia or hyperphosphataemia), dystrophic (in damaged or devitalised tissue), or idiopathic.

### **Soil Contamination**

Environmental toxicology. Heavy metals, pesticides, industrial waste. Remediation: excavation, bioremediation, containment.

### **Solar Urticaria**

A rare form of inducible urticaria triggered by ultraviolet or visible light, producing pruritic erythema and wheals within minutes on exposed skin. Symptoms usually improve after removal from the light source. Diagnosis may involve phototesting.

### **Soleus Muscle**

Broad flat deep posterior leg muscle from posterior tibia, fibula, and tendinous arch to the calcaneus via the Achilles tendon. Innervated by tibial nerve (S1-S2). Powerful ankle plantarflexor, the primary anti-gravity muscle for upright posture. One-joint muscle.

### **Solitary Pulmonary Nodule**

Single, well-circumscribed lesion < 3 cm surrounded by normal lung. Differential includes granuloma, hamartoma, and carcinoma. PET-CT and tissue sampling help determine etiology.

### **Solvent Exposure**

Contact with organic solvents by inhalation, ingestion, or skin absorption. Acute exposure may cause irritation or central nervous system effects; repeated exposure may damage organs.

### **Somatic Mutation**

Acquired genetic change in cancer cells. Not inherited.

### **Somatic Symptom Disorder**

Characterized by one or more somatic symptoms that are distressing or result in significant disruption of daily life, accompanied by excessive thoughts, feelings, or behaviors related to the somatic symptoms.

### **Somatic Variant**

A DNA variant acquired after conception in a non-germline cell lineage. It is not usually transmitted to offspring and may produce mosaic disease or contribute to cancer when it affects growth-control pathways.

### **Somatostatin Analog**

A class of synthetic peptides that mimic the actions of native somatostatin, a hormone that inhibits the secretion of growth hormone, thyroid-stimulating hormone, insulin, glucagon, gastrin, and other GI hormones.

### **Somatostatinoma**

Rare pancreatic or duodenal tumor producing somatostatin causing diabetes, gallstones, steatorrhea, and hypochlorhydria from suppression of insulin, gallbladder contraction, pancreatic enzymes, and gastric acid respectively. Diagnosed by elevated somatostatin levels. Treatment is surgical resection for localized disease.

### **Somatotropic Pituitary Adenoma**

A benign neoplasm of the anterior pituitary arising from growth hormone-secreting cells, causing acromegaly in adults and gigantism in children if occurring before epiphyseal closure.

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## Sonographer

A healthcare professional trained to perform ultrasound scans (sonography).

## Source Control

A procedure or intervention that eliminates, drains, debrides, or otherwise controls an anatomic focus of infection or contamination. Examples include drainage of an abscess, removal of infected tissue or device, and repair of a perforation.

## Soy Protein Intolerance

Adverse gastrointestinal reaction to soy proteins, most often seen in infants and young children. It may cause vomiting, diarrhoea, abdominal pain, blood or mucus in the stool, feeding difficulty, or poor growth.

## Spasticity

Velocity-dependent increase in muscle tone caused by an upper motor-neuron lesion, producing stiffness, spasms, abnormal reflexes, and restricted movement.

## Spasticity Management

Assessment and treatment of abnormal muscle stiffness and spasms. Measures may include stretching, therapy, positioning, medicines, injections, or surgery.

## Spatial Resolution

Ability to distinguish small objects. PET: 4-6 mm. SPECT: 8-12 mm.

## Special Care Baby Unit

A ward within a hospital that provides specialist care for newborn babies who need additional support but not intensive care.

## Special Stain

A histochemical stain that highlights a particular tissue component, organism, or deposited substance not adequately demonstrated by routine hematoxylin and eosin. Examples include periodic acid-Schiff, Ziehl-Neelsen, Congo red, and Gomori

methenamine silver stains.

## Specific Absorbed Fraction

Fraction of emitted energy absorbed in target organ.

## Specific Activity

Radioactivity per unit mass of compound. High specific activity essential for receptor targeting (low receptor density).

## Specific Gravity

Ratio of urine density to water density reflecting solute concentration. Normal 1.005 to 1.030. Less precise than osmolality but faster to measure. Elevated in dehydration, glycosuria, proteinuria, and contrast. Decreased in diabetes insipidus and fluid overload.

## Specific Learning Disorder

A neurodevelopmental disorder causing persistent difficulty acquiring or using academic skills in reading, writing, or mathematics. The difficulties interfere with functioning and are not better explained by another condition or inadequate instruction.

## Specific Phobia

A disorder involving marked, persistent fear or anxiety about a particular object or situation. The fear is excessive relative to the actual danger, leads to avoidance or intense distress, and interferes with daily functioning.

## Specimen Adequacy

The degree to which a collected clinical specimen is sufficient in quantity, correctly identified, properly transported, and representative of the site being tested. Inadequacy can cause invalid, misleading, or falsely negative results.

## Specimen Container

Container for collecting specimens. Types: urine cup, stool container, sputum cup, biohazard bag.

## Specimen Cup

Container for urine or stool samples.

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### **Specimen Transport Medium**

A formulated medium that preserves the viability and diagnostic characteristics of microorganisms during transport from the collection site to the laboratory. The required medium, temperature, container, and transport time depend on the specimen and suspected pathogen.

### **SPECT Scan (Single Photon Emission CT)**

Nuclear medicine imaging using gamma-emitting radioisotopes (Tc-99m, Tl-201, I-123) with a rotating gamma camera to create 3D images.

#### **Synonyms:**

Single Photon Emission CT

### **Spectral Analysis**

Energy discrimination to reject scatter. Energy window typically 20% centered on photopeak.

### **Speech**

Phonation and articulation. Teeth, tongue, lips, palate involved. Dental prostheses may affect speech initially.

### **Speech Delay**

A delay in language development compared to peers: by 12 months—no single words; 18 months—<10-20 words/no word combinations by 24 months; or regression.

### **Speech Discrimination**

Speech discrimination testing, also known as word recognition scoring, measures the ability to understand speech at a comfortable listening level, and it is an important component of the audiometric evaluation that provides information about cochlear and neural function beyond what pure tone audiometry alone can reveal.

#### **Synonyms:**

word recognition scoring, measures the.

### **Speech-Language Pathology Assessment**

Evaluate communication, swallowing, cognition. Standardized tests, clinical observation.

### **Spermatocele**

Benign, painless, fluid-filled cystic retention cavity arising from the epididymis (usually the head/caput), containing avascular fluid and non-viable spermatozoa. Etiology: obstruction of an efferent ductule of the epididymis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cyst, Spermatic

### **Spermatogonium**

A germ cell in the testis that divides and develops into primary spermatocytes.

### **Spermarche**

The onset of sperm production and the first ejaculation, marking an important stage of male puberty.

### **Spermatorrhea**

Involuntary discharge of semen, especially without orgasm.

### **Sphenoid Bone**

Butterfly-shaped bone at the skull base, with body (sphenoid sinuses), greater/lesser wings, and pterygoid processes. The sella turcica houses the pituitary gland.

### **Sphenoid Sinusitis**

Inflammation or infection of the sphenoid sinus, which lies deep behind the nasal cavity. It may cause deep headache, facial pain, or visual symptoms and can rarely spread to nearby nerves or the brain; persistent or severe symptoms require medical assessment.

### **Sphenoidal Sinus**

A paired air-filled sinus within the sphenoid bone at the base of the skull. It lies near important nerves and blood vessels, so inflammation or surgery in this area requires careful assessment.

### **Spherocytes**

Small, dark, sphere-shaped red blood cells lacking central pallor. Formed when RBC membrane is lost without loss of volume, reducing the surface

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area-to-volume ratio.

### **Spider Angioma**

A spider angioma is a central red blood vessel with radiating fine vessels that blanches with pressure and may occur normally or with liver or hormonal disease.

### **Spider Bite**

A cutaneous envenomation resulting from the bite of a spider, ranging from minor local reactions to severe systemic envenomation. The brown recluse spider may cause loxoscelism with necrotic skin lesions, while the black widow spider may cause latrodectism with muscle cramps, hypertension, and autonomic dysfunction.

### **Spina Bifida Meningocele**

A form of spina bifida where the meninges (but not neural tissue) herniate through a vertebral defect, forming a CSF-filled sac. The spinal cord remains in its normal position and is not involved. Presents as a visible, fluid-filled, translucent sac on the back, typically without neurologic deficits.

### **Spina Bifida Myelomeningocele**

The most severe form of spina bifida, where both the meninges and neural tissue (spinal cord and nerve roots) herniate through a vertebral defect. Presents as a visible, flat or sac-like lesion on the back with neurologic deficits below the level of the lesion (paralysis, sensory loss, bowel/bladder dysfunction).

### **Spina Bifida Occulta**

A usually mild form of spina bifida in which the vertebral arch does not fully close without herniation of the spinal cord or meninges. It is often asymptomatic but may be associated with a skin dimple, hair tuft, or other finding over the lower spine.

### **Spinal Analgesia**

Intrathecal administration of a local anesthetic and/or opioid primarily to provide analgesia, often with limited motor block. Intrathecal opioids

can extend postoperative pain relief but may cause pruritus, urinary retention, respiratory depression, and other opioid effects.

### **Spinal Anesthesia**

Injection of local anesthetic into the lumbar subarachnoid space to produce temporary sensory, motor, and sympathetic blockade below the level of injection. Complications include hypotension, bradycardia, urinary retention, post-dural puncture headache, high or total spinal block, infection, and bleeding.

### **Spinal Anesthesia For Cesarean Delivery**

A neuraxial anesthetic technique used for elective and many emergency cesarean deliveries. A small dose of local anesthetic (hyperbaric bupivacaine 12-15 mg) with opioid (fentanyl 15-25 mcg, morphine 0.15-0.25 mg) is injected into the subarachnoid space. Produces rapid surgical anesthesia (T4 sensory level for cesarean).

### **Spinal Angiography**

Contrast imaging of spinal vessels. Evaluates vascular malformations.

### **Spinal Cord Compression**

Oncologic emergency. Back pain, weakness, sensory loss, bowel/bladder dysfunction. MRI diagnostic. Treatment: steroids, radiation, surgery.

### **Spinal Cord Injury**

Spinal cord injury: ASIA impairment scale (A-E). Complete (ASIA A) vs incomplete.

**Synonyms:**

SCI

### **Spinal Dysraphism**

A group of congenital malformations resulting from incomplete closure of the neural tube during embryonic development, affecting the spinal cord and overlying vertebral structures. Includes open defects (myelomeningocele) and closed defects (spina bifida occulta, lipomyelomeningocele, dermal sinus).

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## Spinal Epidural Abscess

A collection of pus in the spinal epidural space, usually caused by haematogenous or contiguous infection. It may present with severe local back pain, fever, spinal tenderness, radicular pain, neurological deficit, or sphincter disturbance, although the classic triad is often incomplete.

## Spinal Fusion

Surgical union of two or more vertebrae using bone graft or bone graft substitutes with instrumentation (rods, screws, cages). Approaches: posterior (posterolateral fusion, transforaminal lumbar interbody fusion TLIF), anterior (anterior lumbar interbody fusion ALIF), and lateral (extreme lateral interbody fusion XLIF).

## Spinal Muscular Atrophy

An inherited disorder causing progressive loss of motor neurons and muscle weakness, often beginning in infancy or childhood but sometimes appearing in adulthood. Severity varies; breathing, swallowing, and mobility may be affected. Early diagnosis allows genetic counseling and disease-modifying care.

## Spinal Nerve

A mixed nerve formed by the union of dorsal and ventral roots as it exits the vertebral canal. There are 31 pairs, carrying sensory, motor, and autonomic fibers to and from the spinal cord.

## Spinal Precautions

Immobilization of spine in trauma patients to prevent neurological injury. Indications: mechanism (fall >3 feet, MVC, gunshot), altered mental status, focal neurological deficit, midline spinal tenderness. Technique: cervical collar, backboard, log roll. Clearance: NEXUS criteria or Canadian C-spine rule.

## Spinal Shock

A state of transient physiological areflexia and flaccid paralysis occurring immediately after acute spinal cord injury, below the level of the lesion.

## Spinal Stenosis

Narrowing of the spinal canal causing compression of the spinal cord or nerve roots. Lumbar stenosis (most common): neurogenic claudication (leg pain/weakness with walking, relieved by sitting/leaning forward), often bilateral.

### Synonyms:

Stenosis, Spinal

## Spindle-Cell Sarcoma

A group of sarcomas characterized by elongated, spindle-shaped malignant cells. It includes entities like leiomyosarcoma, fibrosarcoma, and malignant peripheral nerve sheath tumor, with variable behavior.

## Spine

The vertebral column, consisting of stacked vertebrae that support the body and protect the spinal cord.

## Spine Disorders

The spine, or vertebral column, is a complex bony and soft-tissue structure that provides axial support, protects the spinal cord, and enables flexible movement of the trunk. It consists of 33 vertebrae divided into cervical, thoracic, lumbar, sacral, and coccygeal regions, separated by intervertebral discs that act as shock absorbers.

## Spinocerebellar Ataxias

A group of autosomal dominant neurodegenerative disorders characterized by progressive cerebellar ataxia, often with additional neurological features. Over forty different SCA types have been identified, with SCA1, SCA2, SCA3 (Machado-Joseph disease, the most common worldwide), SCA6, and SCA7 being the most prevalent.

## Spirochete

A thin, coiled gram-negative bacterium with internal periplasmic flagella conferring corkscrew motility, requiring darkfield or special stains. Pathogenic genera include *Treponema* (syphilis), *Borrelia* (Lyme disease, relapsing fever), and *Leptospira* (leptospirosis), diagnosed mainly by serology and darkfield

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microscopy.

### **Spirometry**

Most common PFT measuring air volume and flow during forced breathing. Key measurements: FVC, FEV1, FEV1/FVC ratio. Used to diagnose and classify obstructive and restrictive diseases.

### **Spleen Hilum**

Concave medial surface where the tortuous splenic artery (celiac trunk branch) enters and splenic vein exits, with lymphatics and nerves. Artery divides into 5 segmental branches at the hilum (basis for partial splenectomy). Splenic vein joins the superior mesenteric vein forming the portal vein.

### **Splenic Cyst**

A fluid-filled lesion within the spleen, classified as true cysts with an epithelial lining, including congenital, epidermoid, and dermoid cysts, or pseudocysts without a lining, typically resulting from trauma, infection, or pancreatitis. Most are asymptomatic and discovered incidentally on imaging.

### **Splenic Infarction**

Ischemic necrosis of splenic tissue caused by obstruction of splenic arterial or venous blood flow. Causes include embolism, thrombosis, hematologic disease, hypercoagulability, infection, trauma, or vasculitis; it often causes sudden left-upper-quadrant pain and is evaluated with imaging.

### **Splenic Rupture**

A tear of the spleen, usually after blunt abdominal trauma but sometimes spontaneous in an enlarged or diseased spleen. It can cause life-threatening internal bleeding; diagnosis and treatment depend on hemodynamic stability and imaging, with urgent surgery or embolization sometimes required.

### **Splice-Site Variant**

A variant affecting the sequences required for accurate removal of introns and joining of exons during RNA processing. It may cause abnormal transcripts, exon skipping, intron retention, or reduced functional protein.

### **Splint**

Immobilizes injured body part. Types: aluminum, plastic, canvas, pneumatic.

### **Splint (Dental)**

Fixation of mobile teeth or fractured tooth. Wire and composite, orthodontic bracket splint.

**Synonyms:**

Dental

### **Splinter Hemorrhages**

Linear hemorrhages under the nail bed, oriented longitudinally. In infective endocarditis, they are caused by septic microemboli to the nail bed capillaries. They are a minor Duke criterion. Splinter hemorrhages can also result from trauma, psoriasis, and systemic vasculitis.

### **Splitting**

A psychological defense pattern in which a person or situation is viewed as entirely good or entirely bad, with difficulty integrating positive and negative qualities. It can occur in several mental-health conditions and is not diagnostic by itself.

### **Spondyloarthritis**

Group of inflammatory arthritis associated with HLA-B27. Includes ankylosing spondylitis, psoriatic arthritis, reactive arthritis, enteropathic arthritis. Features: axial involvement, enthesitis, dactylitis.

### **Sponge (Vascular)**

A sterile absorbent material used during vascular procedures to control minor bleeding or protect tissue.

**Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Spontaneous Bacterial Peritonitis**

Infection of ascitic fluid without an identifiable intra-abdominal source representing a serious complication of cirrhosis with ascites. The pathogenesis involves impaired immune function, bacterial translocation from the intestinal lumen, and seeding of ascitic fluid which provides a favorable medium for



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bacterial growth.

### **Spontaneous Breathing Trial**

A period of unsupported breathing to assess a patient's readiness for extubation. The patient breathes through a T-piece or with minimal pressure support for 30–120 minutes. Successful SBT predicts successful extubation.

### **Spontaneous Pneumothorax**

Pneumothorax without trauma. Primary in healthy individuals; secondary with underlying lung disease. Treatment depends on size.

### **Sporotrichosis**

Sporotrichosis is a fungal infection caused by *Sporothrix* species, often introduced through plant matter and producing nodules along lymphatic channels.

### **Sports Rehabilitation**

Rehabilitation that restores safe movement and performance after a sports-related injury.

### **Sprain**

An injury to a ligament (connective tissue connecting bone to bone) caused by excessive stretching or tearing. Grading: Grade I (mild stretching, microscopic tears), Grade II (partial tear with laxity), Grade III (complete tear with instability).

### **Sprengel Deformity**

A congenital elevation of the scapula due to failure of the scapula to descend from its embryonic cervical position to its normal thoracic position during weeks 9–12 of gestation. The scapula is higher, smaller, and rotated inferiorly compared to the normal side. Range of motion is limited, especially in shoulder abduction.

### **Spur-Cell Hemolytic Anemia**

A severe hemolytic anemia seen in advanced liver disease where acanthocytosis develops due to altered membrane cholesterol, causing premature red cell destruction in the spleen.

### **Squamous Cell Carcinoma**

Cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma is a malignant keratinocyte tumor commonly arising on chronically sun-exposed skin or in areas of chronic inflammation or immunosuppression. It may present as a scaly, indurated, hyperkeratotic papule, plaque, or ulcer.

### **ST Segment**

The isoelectric period between ventricular depolarization (QRS) and repolarization (T wave). It corresponds to the plateau phase of ventricular action potentials. ST segment elevation (>1 mm in limb leads or >2 mm in precordial leads) suggests acute myocardial infarction, pericarditis, or early repolarization.

### **ST-Segment Elevation**

Elevation of the ECG ST segment above the isoelectric baseline, reflecting abnormal ventricular repolarization. It may indicate acute coronary occlusion but can also occur in pericarditis, early repolarization, ventricular aneurysm, or other conditions; interpretation requires clinical context and serial testing.

### **St. John's Wort**

Herbal supplement. CYP3A4 inducer, reduces efficacy of many drugs (oral contraceptives, warfarin, antiretrovirals).

### **Stab Wound**

A penetrating sharp-force injury in which wound track depth exceeds skin defect length, produced by a pointed or sharp-edged implement. The skin defect approximates blade width only when perpendicular to Langer's lines, and a single-edged blade produces one sharp and one blunt end.

### **Stable Disease**

Cancer neither growing nor shrinking significantly.

### **Stage I**

A cancer stage that generally indicates limited disease, although the exact definition and prognosis depend on the cancer type and staging system.

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## Stage II

A cancer stage whose meaning depends on the cancer type and may indicate a larger primary tumor or limited local spread without distant metastasis.

## Stage III

A cancer stage that often indicates more extensive local or regional disease, with the precise criteria depending on the cancer type.

## Stage IV

A cancer stage that generally indicates spread to distant organs or sites. Prognosis and treatment vary by cancer type and individual factors.

## Stages Of Labor

Four stages describing the progression from uterine contractions to delivery of the placenta. First stage: onset of regular contractions to full cervical dilatation (10 cm). Second stage: full dilatation to delivery of the baby. Third stage: delivery of the baby to delivery of the placenta.

## Staining

A laboratory technique applying dyes to microbial smears or tissue sections to visualise microorganisms and reveal structural characteristics. Major methods include Gram, acid-fast, Giemsa, and fluorescent stains, providing rapid presumptive identification from clinical specimens and guiding initial empiric therapy.

## Stainless Steel

Alloy for preformed crowns, orthodontic bands, instruments. Corrosion-resistant.

## Standard Of Care

The conduct, skill, diligence, and judgment a reasonably prudent practitioner of the same specialty would exercise under similar circumstances; the benchmark for medical negligence. It is established through guidelines, peer practice, and expert testimony rather than fixed statute.

## Standard Precautions

Precautions for all patient care. Examples: hand hygiene, PPE, safe injection, respiratory hygiene.

## Standardized Uptake Value

Quantitative PET measure: tissue activity divided by injected dose per body weight. Normalizes for body size, injection dose. SUVmax: maximum pixel value in lesion. SUVmean: average lesion uptake. Background: blood pool, liver.

## Staph Infection

Infections caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* (and coagulase-negative staphylococci), a gram-positive coccus in clusters.

### Synonyms:

Staphylococcus Infection (Staph Infection)

## Staphylococcal Infection

An infection caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* or another *Staphylococcus* species. It may affect the skin, bone, joints, lungs, heart valves, blood, or other tissues. Diagnosis and antimicrobial treatment depend on the site, severity, and susceptibility of the organism.

## Staphylococcal Pneumonia

Severe pneumonia from *S. aureus*, often post-influenza. May cause necrotizing pneumonia, lung abscess, and empyema.

## Staphylococcal Scalded Skin

A toxin-mediated *Staphylococcus aureus* infection causing superficial separation and tenderness of the outer skin, usually in infants or young children. Widespread redness and fragile blisters may rupture to leave painful, moist areas resembling a scald burn and require prompt medical assessment.

## Staphylococcus Aureus

A gram-positive, catalase-positive, coagulase-positive coccus that causes a wide range of infections including skin infections, pneumonia, endocarditis, and osteomyelitis. *S. aureus* produces numerous virulence factors including toxins, enzymes, and sur-

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face proteins. MRSA strains carry the *mecA* gene encoding PBP2a.

### **Staple (Vascular)**

A small metal or polymer device used to close tissue or connect vascular structures.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Stargardt Disease**

The most common inherited macular dystrophy, usually autosomal recessive and caused by ABCA4 gene mutations. Presents in childhood or adolescence with progressive central vision loss, retinal flecks, and bull's-eye maculopathy; no curative treatment exists.

### **Starling Forces**

Starling forces describe the balance of hydrostatic and oncotic pressures that govern fluid movement across capillary walls, determining the distribution of fluid between the intravascular and extravascular compartments.

### **Statin**

An inhibitor of HMG-CoA reductase that lowers hepatic cholesterol synthesis and increases hepatic LDL-receptor expression. Statins reduce atherosclerotic cardiovascular events; adverse effects include muscle symptoms, rare severe myopathy, and liver-enzyme abnormalities.

### **Statins In Diabetes**

Use of HMG-CoA reductase inhibitors to reduce atherosclerotic cardiovascular risk in people with diabetes. The decision, intensity, and treatment target are individualized according to age, cardiovascular risk, kidney function, and other clinical factors.

### **Station**

The relationship of the fetal presenting part to the level of the ischial spines, measured in centimeters.

### **Steady State**

The condition where the rate of drug administration equals the rate of elimination, resulting in constant average plasma concentrations with repeated dosing. During regular dosing at fixed intervals, steady state is achieved after approximately 4 to 5 half-lives, regardless of the dosing frequency or dose size.

### **Steal Syndrome**

Ischemia of distal extremity due to blood flow diversion to bypass graft or AV fistula. Most common: upper extremity after AV fistula creation. Symptoms: hand pain, pallor, numbness, weakness. Treatment: banding, ligation, revision.

### **Steatorrhea**

The passage of excess fat in the stool, causing greasy, pale, foul-smelling, floating stools—a hallmark of fat malabsorption.

### **Stem Cell Transplantation**

Hematopoietic stem cell transplantation (HSCT) replaces diseased or ablated bone marrow with healthy donor or autologous stem cells.

### **STEMI**

ST-elevation myocardial infarction: transmural myocardial necrosis from acute total occlusion of a coronary artery, an emergency requiring immediate reperfusion. ECG: ST-segment elevation in contiguous leads (or new LBBB); troponin elevated.

### **Stenosis Of The Left Anterior Descending Artery**

Narrowing of the left anterior descending coronary artery, which can reduce blood flow to the front of the heart and cause ischemia.

### **Stenotrophomonas Maltophilia Resistance**

Resistance in *Stenotrophomonas maltophilia* results from intrinsic and acquired mechanisms that limit the activity of several antibiotics. Treatment should be guided by the site of infection, susceptibility testing, illness severity, and specialist advice.

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### **Stent (Vascular)**

A small mesh or tube placed inside a narrowed or blocked vessel to help keep it open.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Stent Balloon (Vascular)**

A balloon catheter used to expand a stent against the wall of a blood vessel.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Stent Graft**

A fabric-covered stent placed inside a blood vessel to reinforce the vessel wall or exclude an aneurysm from blood flow.

### **Stent Placement**

Image-guided deployment of stent. Vascular, biliary, ureteral, esophageal. Maintains patency.

### **Stent-Graft (Vascular)**

A fabric-covered vascular stent used to reinforce a vessel or exclude an aneurysm or leak.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Stenting**

Placement of mesh tube to keep vessel open. Drug-eluting stents reduce restenosis.

### **Stepping Reflex**

A primitive reflex present from birth to 2 months, elicited by holding the infant upright with feet touching a flat surface. The infant makes stepping-like movements as if walking. Disappears by 2 months as voluntary motor control develops. Reappears around 9-10 months as voluntary walking emerges.

### **Stereotactic Biopsy**

Biopsy using stereotactic guidance. Breast, brain, lung.

### **Stereotactic Body Radiation Therapy**

A highly precise form of external radiation deliver-

ing high-dose ablative treatment in few fractions, used for early-stage lung cancer and selected liver, pancreatic, spinal, and kidney tumors.

### **Stereotactic Radiosurgery**

Single high-dose radiation to small target. Used for brain metastases, AVMs, acoustic neuroma.

### **Sterile Field**

A designated area maintained free of viable microorganisms during an invasive procedure. Only sterile equipment and materials may contact the field or the sterile portions of instruments.

### **Sterile Site**

A body site or specimen type expected to contain no viable microorganisms in health, such as blood, cerebrospinal fluid, synovial fluid, or tissue from a closed space. Recovery of a pathogen from a sterile site is generally clinically significant, subject to contamination assessment.

### **Sterilization**

A process eliminating all microbial life including spores, achieving a sterility assurance level of at least  $10^{-6}$ .

### **Sternoclavicular Joint**

A saddle-type synovial joint between the clavicle and manubrium of the sternum. It is the only bony connection between the upper limb and axial skeleton and permits movement of the shoulder girdle.

### **Sternocleidomastoid Muscle**

Strap-like anterior neck muscle from manubrium and medial clavicle to the mastoid process. Innervated by CN XI and C2-C3. Divides neck into anterior/posterior triangles. Unilaterally: laterally flexes to opposite side, rotates face to same side. Bilaterally: flexes neck, assists forced inspiration.

### **Stickler Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant connective tissue disorder caused by mutations in collagen genes (COL2A1 most common, also COL11A1, COL11A2,

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COL9A1).

### **Stimulant Use Disorder**

A problematic pattern of stimulant use (cocaine, amphetamines, methamphetamine, MDMA) leading to significant impairment. Stimulants increase dopamine and norepinephrine activity. Withdrawal is characterized by fatigue, depression, increased appetite, hypersomnia, psychomotor retardation, and vivid unpleasant dreams.

### **Stippling (Tattooing)**

Patterned dermal abrasions and punctate hemorrhages surrounding a firearm entrance wound, caused by unburned and partially burned gunpowder grains striking the skin at close range (15–75 cm).

#### **Synonyms:**

Tattooing

### **Stochastic Effects**

Random radiation effects with no threshold. Cancer, genetic effects. Probability increases with dose.

### **Stoma Complications**

Complications related to intestinal or urinary stomas.

### **Stomach Cancer**

Malignant cancer arising in the stomach, most often an adenocarcinoma. Risk factors include *Helicobacter pylori* infection, smoking, certain dietary exposures, chronic gastric inflammation, and inherited syndromes. Symptoms, stage, and tumor type guide treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Gastric Cancer, Stomach

### **Stomach Ulcer**

An open sore in the lining of the stomach, commonly associated with *Helicobacter pylori* infection or medicines such as NSAIDs.

### **STOPP/START**

Screening Tool of Older Person's Prescriptions

(STOPP) and Potential Older Person's Prescriptions (START). Identifies inappropriate prescribing.

### **Storage Diseases**

A group of inherited metabolic disorders characterized by accumulation of substrates within cells due to specific enzyme deficiencies. Lysosomal storage diseases result from defects in lysosomal hydrolytic enzymes, leading to accumulation of undigested macromolecules within lysosomes.

### **Strain Imaging**

Echocardiographic or magnetic-resonance imaging that measures deformation of the myocardium during contraction and relaxation. It can detect abnormalities in myocardial function that may not be apparent from ejection fraction alone.

### **Strength Testing**

Manual muscle testing, dynamometry, isokinetic testing. Quantifies weakness, tracks progress.

### **Streptococcal Cellulitis With Lymphangitis**

Streptococcal infection of the skin and subcutaneous tissue with inflammation of the draining lymphatic vessels.

### **Streptococcal Infection**

Infections caused by *Streptococcus pyogenes* (Group A Strep, GAS). Common presentations: pharyngitis (strep throat), scarlet fever (pharyngitis with erythematous rash), impetigo, cellulitis, and necrotizing fasciitis.

### **Streptococcal Pharyngitis**

Sore throat caused by infection with group A *Streptococcus*, often accompanied by fever and swollen cervical lymph nodes.

### **Streptococcus Agalactiae**

A gram-positive, beta-hemolytic streptococcus (Group B *Streptococcus*) that is a leading cause of neonatal sepsis, meningitis, and pneumonia. The organism colonises the gastrointestinal and geni-

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tal tracts. Transmission occurs during birth. Risk factors include prematurity, prolonged rupture of membranes, and maternal colonisation.

### **Streptococcus Pneumoniae**

A gram-positive, encapsulated diplococcus that causes pneumonia, otitis media, sinusitis, meningitis, and sepsis.

### **Streptococcus Pyogenes**

A gram-positive, beta-hemolytic streptococcus (Group A Streptococcus) that causes pharyngitis, skin infections, and post-infectious complications including rheumatic fever and glomerulonephritis. The organism produces streptolysins, erythrogenic toxin, and streptokinase.

### **Stress Cardiomyopathy**

A temporary weakening of the heart muscle, often following intense emotional or physical stress, with symptoms that can resemble acute coronary syndrome.

### **Stress Echocardiography**

Echocardiography during exercise or pharmacological stress. Detects coronary artery disease by identifying wall motion abnormalities.

### **Stress Fracture**

A bone injury caused by repetitive submaximal loading that exceeds the rate of remodeling and repair. It often presents with gradually increasing, localized activity-related pain and may progress to a complete fracture if loading continues.

### **Stress Shielding**

Reduction in physiologic loading of adjacent bone caused by an implant that carries a disproportionate share of mechanical force. Chronic stress shielding may lead to bone resorption and compromise fixation.

### **Stress Ulcer Prophylaxis**

Prevention of stress-related mucosal disease in critically ill patients. Risk factors: mechanical ven-

tilation >48 hours, coagulopathy, trauma, burns, sepsis. Agents: H2 blockers, proton pump inhibitors. Duration: while risk factors present.

### **Stress Urinary Incontinence**

Involuntary leakage of urine, significantly affecting psychological, social, and physical well-being. See urinary incontinence.

### **Stretch Reflex**

A monosynaptic spinal reflex in which stretching a muscle (e.g., a tap on the patellar tendon) excites muscle spindles, generating an afferent signal (Ia fibers) that directly excites the alpha motor neurons of the same muscle, causing contraction and resistance to stretch.

### **Striae Gravidarum**

Stretch marks that develop during pregnancy, commonly on the abdomen, breasts, thighs, or buttocks. They may begin as red or purple lines and gradually fade to lighter bands.

### **Stripping Of Membranes (Membrane Sweep)**

A procedure performed during a cervical exam where the examiner inserts a finger through the internal os and sweeps the membranes circumferentially, separating them from the lower uterine segment. Releases endogenous prostaglandins, promoting cervical ripening and potentially initiating labor.

#### **Synonyms:**

Membrane Sweep

### **Stroke Volume**

The volume of blood ejected by the left ventricle with each heartbeat, normally 60-100 mL. It is determined by three factors: preload, afterload, and myocardial contractility. Stroke volume equals end-diastolic volume minus end-systolic volume. Reduced stroke volume occurs in heart failure, hypovolemia, and cardiogenic shock.

### **Strongyloides Stercoralis**

A soil-transmitted nematode that can infect the



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human intestine and cause strongyloidiasis.

### Structured Reporting

Reporting using standardized templates. Improves consistency, completeness.

### Struvite Stones

Infection stones composed of magnesium ammonium phosphate. Form in alkaline urine with urease-producing organisms including *Proteus* and *Klebsiella*. Staghorn calculi fill renal pelvis almost exclusively from *Proteus*. Treatment requires complete stone removal with antibiotics and urinary acidification. High recurrence if infection persists.

### Sturge-Weber Syndrome

A neurocutaneous syndrome (phakomatosis) characterized by a facial capillary malformation (port-wine stain) in the V1 distribution of the trigeminal nerve (forehead and upper eyelid) and ipsilateral leptomeningeal angiomas (venous malformations of the pia mater). Caused by a somatic activating mutation in *GNAQ*.

### Subacute Rehabilitation

Less intensive than acute rehab. For patients needing continued therapy but not as intensive. Skilled nursing facility setting.

### Subacute Thyroiditis

Inflammatory condition of the thyroid most likely viral in etiology presenting with painful tender thyroid enlargement, fever, and malaise. Associated with elevated erythrocyte sedimentation rate and C-reactive protein.

### Subarachnoid

Situated beneath the arachnoid membrane surrounding the brain and spinal cord.

### Subarachnoid Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the subarachnoid space, the area between the arachnoid membrane and the pia mater surrounding the brain, most commonly caused by rupture of a cerebral (berry) aneurysm.

### Subclavian Artery

The artery supplying the upper limb, arising on the right from the brachiocephalic trunk and on the left directly from the aortic arch, passing over the first rib and becoming the axillary artery. Branches: vertebral, internal thoracic, thyrocervical trunk, costocervical trunk.

### Subclavian Vein

The continuation of the axillary vein beyond the lateral border of the first rib. It joins the internal jugular vein behind the sternoclavicular joint to form the brachiocephalic vein.

### Subclavian Vein Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot in the subclavian vein, often associated with central venous catheterization, thoracic outlet syndrome, or Paget-Schroetter syndrome (effort-related thrombosis in young, active individuals). Presents with arm swelling, pain, and cyanosis.

### Subcorneal Pustular Dermatitis

A chronic relapsing skin disorder characterized by superficial sterile pustules beneath the stratum corneum, often on the trunk and flexural areas. It may be associated with IgA or other monoclonal gammopathies and can resemble pustular psoriasis.

### Subculture

The transfer of microorganisms from one culture to fresh culture medium, used to maintain pure cultures, isolate colonies, increase viability, prepare standardized inocula, and perform identification/susceptibility testing. On solid media, subculture aims to obtain isolated single colonies from a mixed or stock culture.

### Subcutaneous Emphysema

Air in the subcutaneous tissues, often from pneumothorax, pneumomediastinum, or chest trauma. It causes a characteristic crepitus on palpation. It is usually benign and resolves when the underlying air leak is treated. Severe cases may cause skin necrosis and compartment syndrome.

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### Subcutaneous Tissue

Subcutaneous tissue (hypodermis, superficial fascia) lies beneath the dermis and connects skin to underlying structures. It contains adipose tissue (fat), blood vessels, nerves, and the superficial muscular aponeurotic system (SMAS). Subcutaneous fat provides insulation, cushioning, and energy storage.

### Subdural Hematoma

A collection of blood between the dura mater and the arachnoid mater, caused by tearing of bridging veins that traverse the subdural space.

### Subgaleal Hemorrhage

A potentially life-threatening accumulation of blood in the space beneath the scalp's epicranial aponeurosis. It can expand rapidly in a newborn, particularly after vacuum-assisted delivery, and requires urgent recognition and treatment.

### Sublingual Epidermoid Cyst

A benign cyst lined by stratified squamous epithelium beneath the tongue mucosa, presenting as a slow-growing midline swelling that may require surgical excision if symptomatic.

### Sublingual Gland

One of the paired major salivary glands, located beneath the tongue. It produces mainly mucous saliva that enters the mouth through several small ducts and helps lubricate the oral cavity.

### Submandibular Gland

One of the three paired major salivary glands, located in the submandibular triangle beneath the mandible. Mixed gland (predominantly serous) secreting saliva via Wharton's duct opening at the sublingual caruncle (floor of mouth). Saliva contains amylase, mucins, lysozyme, IgA.

### Subscapular Artery

An artery arising from the axillary artery that supplies the scapular region and adjacent muscles.

### Substance Abuse

An older, nonspecific term for harmful or problematic substance use. Current clinical language generally uses substance-use disorder.

### Substance Abuse Psychiatry

The subspecialty focused on the evaluation and treatment of substance use disorders and co-occurring psychiatric conditions. Dual diagnosis patients require integrated treatment addressing both disorders simultaneously.

### Substance Dependence

A state in which repeated substance use produces physiologic adaptation, so that reducing or stopping the substance may cause withdrawal. It is distinct from, but may occur with, substance-use disorder.

### Substance Intoxication

A reversible substance-specific syndrome caused by recent use that produces clinically significant behavioral or physiologic changes. Diagnosis requires assessing timing, dose or exposure, expected pharmacology, co-ingestants, and medical complications.

### Substance Use

The consumption of alcohol, drugs, or other chemical substances, which can lead to health, social, and psychological issues if used excessively.

### Substance Use Disorder

A problematic pattern of substance use leading to clinically significant impairment or distress, manifested by at least two of eleven criteria within a twelve-month period.

### Substance Use In Pregnancy

Use of alcohol, tobacco, cannabis, opioids, cocaine, or other substances during pregnancy. Effects depend on the substance, dose, timing, and other factors and may include maternal complications, impaired fetal growth, preterm birth, or neonatal withdrawal. Evaluation and treatment should be individualized.

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## Substance Withdrawal

A substance-specific syndrome occurring after reduction or cessation of heavy or prolonged use. Withdrawal can range from discomfort to life-threatening complications such as seizures, delirium tremens, severe autonomic instability, or respiratory depression depending on the substance.

## Substernal Goiter

Extension of thyroid tissue into the mediastinum, typically arising from the thyroid gland in the neck and growing downward through the thoracic inlet. It may cause compressive symptoms including dyspnea, dysphagia, and superior vena cava syndrome. Most are multinodular goiters. Diagnosis is by CT or MRI.

## Succenturiat Lobe

An accessory lobe of the placenta, connected to the main placenta by blood vessels that traverse the membranes. If undetected after delivery, the succenturiat lobe may be retained in the uterus, causing postpartum hemorrhage or infection. Diagnosis: careful inspection of the placenta and membranes after delivery.

## Succinate Dehydrogenase

Complex II of electron transport chain. Also TCA cycle enzyme. Produces FADH<sub>2</sub>.

## Succinylcholine

A depolarizing neuromuscular-blocking drug that produces rapid, brief skeletal-muscle paralysis by activating nicotinic acetylcholine receptors at the neuromuscular junction. It can cause hyperkalemia, bradycardia, myalgia, masseter spasm, prolonged apnea in pseudocholinesterase deficiency, and malignant hyperthermia.

## Sucking Reflex

A primitive reflex present from birth, elicited by placing an object in the infant's mouth. The infant rhythmically sucks on the object. Coordinated sucking and swallowing typically develop by 34-36 weeks gestational age. Premature infants may lack coordinated suck-swallow, requiring gavage feeding.

## Sucrose Lysis Test

A historical screening test for paroxysmal nocturnal haemoglobinuria in which patient red blood cells are exposed to serum in a low-ionic-strength sucrose solution, allowing complement-mediated lysis to be detected.

## Suction (Vascular)

A suction device used during a vascular procedure to remove blood or other fluid from the operative field.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Suction Device

Creates negative pressure for fluid removal. Components: canister, tubing, suction catheter. Used for airway clearance, surgical field, wound drainage.

## Suction Tip

The end attachment of a suction device used to remove blood, fluid, secretions, or debris. Common types include the Yankauer tip for oropharyngeal suction and surgical suction tips such as the Frink tip.

## Sudden Cardiac Death

Unexpected death from a cardiac cause, usually occurring rapidly after symptom onset or without witnessed symptoms. Causes include coronary disease, cardiomyopathy, inherited arrhythmia syndromes, and bradyarrhythmia; prevention depends on the underlying risk.

### Synonyms:

Arrest Cardiac (Sudden Cardiac Death) Death Sudden Cardiac (Sudden Cardiac Death)

## Sudden Infant Death Syndrome

SIDS: the sudden, unexplained death of an infant <1 year (peak 2-4 months) that remains unexplained after a thorough investigation (autopsy, scene examination, and review of clinical history). Risk factors: prone sleep, bed-sharing, soft bedding, overheating, maternal smoking, prematurity/low birth weight, and co-sleeping.

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### Sudden Sensorineural Hearing Loss

Rapid sensorineural hearing loss, conventionally at least 30 dB over three contiguous frequencies within 72 hours. It requires urgent audiologic and otologic assessment because early treatment may improve recovery in selected patients.

### Sudden Unexpected Infant Death

The sudden and unexpected death of an infant younger than 1 year, whether or not the cause is known before investigation. Sudden infant death syndrome is the unexplained subtype after complete scene, history, and autopsy evaluation.

### Sugammadex

A selective relaxant binding agent that reverses aminosteroid neuromuscular blockers (rocuronium and vecuronium) by encapsulating them in a cyclodextrin molecule, forming a 1:1 complex that is renally excreted. Onset of action is within 2 to 3 minutes.

### Suicidal Ideation

Thoughts about killing oneself, ranging from passive (wish to be dead, wishes to fall asleep and not wake) to active (thoughts of killing oneself with varying degrees of intent, plan, and means). The C-SSRS grades severity from 1 (wish to be dead) to 5 (active suicidal ideation with specific plan and intent).

### Suicide Risk Assessment

A clinical evaluation of suicidal thoughts, intent, plan, access to means, past attempts, self-harm, psychiatric and medical illness, substance use, protective factors, and immediate safety. It informs but does not replace ongoing clinical judgment and safety planning.

### Sulfa Drugs

A class of bacteriostatic antibiotics that competitively inhibit dihydropteroate synthase, an enzyme essential for folic acid synthesis in bacteria. See sulfonamides.

### Sulfatide

A sulfated glycolipid found particularly in myelin

and nervous tissue.

### Sulfonamide

A class of antibiotics (sulfamethoxazole, sulfadiazine, sulfasalazine) that inhibit bacterial dihydropteroate synthase, blocking folate synthesis—bacteriostatic. Often combined with trimethoprim (co-trimoxazole: TMP-SMX). Used for UTIs, PCP (pneumocystis pneumonia), toxoplasmosis, *Nocardia*, and MRSA.

### Sulfonylureas

Oral antidiabetic agents that stimulate insulin secretion from pancreatic beta cells by blocking ATP-sensitive potassium channels on the beta cell membrane. This causes membrane depolarization, opening of voltage-gated calcium channels, calcium influx, and exocytosis of insulin-containing granules.

### Sulfur Colloid Scan

Nuclear medicine imaging using Tc-99m sulfur colloid. Evaluates liver, spleen, bone marrow, lymph nodes.

### Sulphonamides

A class of antimicrobial agents containing the sulfonamide group ( $\text{SO}_2\text{NH}_2$ ). Sulphonamides were the first effective systemic antibacterial agents (Prontosil, 1935—Gerhard Domagk). Mechanism: competitive inhibition of dihydropteroate synthase, blocking folate synthesis (para-aminobenzoic acid analogue)—bacteriostatic.

### Sun Protection (Photoprotection)

Sun protection involves measures taken to reduce exposure to ultraviolet radiation from the sun, which is the primary environmental risk factor for skin cancer and photoaging.

#### Synonyms:

Photoprotection

### Superantigen

A protein that bypasses antigen processing and non-specifically activates large T-cell populations by binding MHC class II and the T-cell receptor V region, triggering massive cytokine release. Staphylococcal TSST-1 and enterotoxins, and streptococcal

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pyrogenic exotoxins, cause toxic shock and scarlet fever.

### **Superficial Fascia**

A layer of loose connective tissue beneath the dermis, also called subcutaneous tissue or the hypodermis.

#### **Synonyms:**

subcutaneous tissue.

### **Superficial Thrombophlebitis**

Superficial thrombophlebitis is inflammation and clotting in a vein near the skin, causing a tender red cord; extension into deep veins must be assessed.

### **Superimposed Preeclampsia**

Preeclampsia developing in a person who already has chronic hypertension. It may present with new or worsening proteinuria, thrombocytopenia, abnormal liver or kidney tests, neurologic symptoms, or other features of maternal organ dysfunction.

### **Superinfection**

A new infection that develops during or after treatment of a previous infection, often involving an antimicrobial-resistant organism or an organism not susceptible to the original therapy, such as *Clostridioides difficile* after antibiotic exposure.

### **Superior**

Positioned higher or closer to the head.

### **Superior Mesenteric Artery**

Second major abdominal aortic branch at L1, the midgut artery. Supplies distal duodenum through proximal two-thirds of transverse colon. Branches: inferior pancreaticoduodenal, jejunal, ileal, ileocolic, right colic, middle colic. Arises anterior to the pancreatic uncinate process, crosses the third duodenal part.

### **Superior Mesenteric Artery Syndrome**

Compression of the duodenum between the aorta and the superior mesenteric artery, causing proximal duodenal obstruction. Presents with postprandial nausea, vomiting, and epigastric pain, often after

significant weight loss that narrows the SMA-aortic angle. Treatment includes nutritional rehabilitation and surgical duodenal mobilization.

### **Superior Semicircular Canal Dehiscence**

A defect or marked thinning of the bony covering of the superior semicircular canal that can produce sound- or pressure-induced vertigo, autophony, and conductive-appearing hearing findings. Diagnosis combines characteristic symptoms, physiologic testing, and high-resolution temporal-bone CT.

### **Superior Vena Cava**

Formed by brachiocephalic vein junction at the first right costal cartilage, returning upper body deoxygenated blood to the right atrium. Approximately 7 cm, valveless. Related to right lung/pleura, right phrenic nerve, and azygos vein.

### **Superior Vena Cava Syndrome**

Obstruction of SVC by tumor. Facial swelling, dyspnea, dilated neck veins. Emergency: radiation, stenting.

#### **Synonyms:**

SVCS (Superior Vena Cava Syndrome)

### **Superior Vena Caval Obstruction**

Compression or thrombosis of the superior vena cava impairing venous return from the head, neck, and upper extremities. Most commonly caused by malignancy (lung cancer, lymphoma) or indwelling central venous devices. Presents with facial swelling, plethora, distended neck veins, and upper extremity edema.

### **Supernumerary Rib**

An extra rib beyond the typical twelve pairs, most commonly a cervical rib above the first thoracic rib, which may compress the brachial plexus or subclavian vessel causing thoracic outlet syndrome.

### **Supernumerary Teeth**

Extra teeth beyond normal complement. Most common: mesiodens between maxillary centrals. May cause impaction or malocclusion.



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### **Supervised Exercise Therapy**

A structured, monitored exercise program used to improve walking ability and reduce claudication symptoms in people with peripheral artery disease. The exercise plan is adjusted to the person's symptoms and functional capacity.

### **Supine Hypotensive Syndrome**

Compression of the inferior vena cava by the gravid uterus when the pregnant woman lies flat on her back after 20 weeks gestation. Results in decreased venous return, reduced cardiac output, and maternal hypotension, dizziness, pallor, and syncope.

### **Supplemental Oxygen Therapy**

Administration of oxygen at a concentration above that of room air to treat or prevent clinically important hypoxemia. Delivery method and oxygen target depend on the illness, baseline oxygenation, risk of carbon-dioxide retention, and monitoring results; excessive oxygen can also cause harm.

### **Supplementation**

Use of a vitamin, mineral, protein, fiber, or other nutrient preparation to correct a deficiency or meet a clinically identified increased requirement. The indication, dose, interactions, product quality, and risk of toxicity should be assessed before use.

### **Supportive Care**

Treatment that maintains essential body functions, relieves symptoms, prevents complications, and supports recovery while the underlying cause is treated.

### **Supraglottic Airway Device**

An airway device positioned above the glottis to maintain oxygenation and ventilation without passing through the vocal cords. It is used for selected anesthetized or unconscious patients and is not a definitive substitute for a cuffed tracheal tube when aspiration protection is required.

### **Suprascapular Nerve**

A branch of the brachial plexus that supplies the supraspinatus and infraspinatus muscles.

### **Surgical Drain**

A device placed to remove blood, pus, bile, urine, lymph, or other fluid from a surgical site or body cavity. Indications, output characteristics, duration, and removal criteria should be documented because drains can also cause infection, bleeding, or tissue injury.

### **Surgical Hemostasis**

Control of bleeding during an operation using pressure, ligation, sutures, clips, electrosurgery, topical agents, vessel sealing, or other techniques. Effective hemostasis requires identification of the bleeding source and correction of coagulopathy when present.

### **Surgical Instruments**

Instruments for surgery. Categories: cutting (scalpel, scissors), grasping (forceps, clamps), retraction, hemostasis (hemostat, electrocautery).

### **Surgical Margin**

The edge of tissue removed during an excision or resection, assessed microscopically for residual disease. A negative margin has no tumor at the examined edge; a positive margin indicates tumor extends to the inked or designated margin.

### **Surgical Repair**

An operation that restores or reconstructs damaged tissue, an organ, or an anatomic function.

### **Surgical Risk Stratification**

Estimation of the likelihood of perioperative complications using patient factors, urgency, procedure risk, functional capacity, and disease-specific assessment. It informs optimization, monitoring level, shared decisions, and postoperative planning but cannot eliminate uncertainty.

### **Surgical Safety Checklist**

A structured checklist used at defined points before anesthesia, before incision, and before leaving the operating room to verify patient identity, procedure, site, consent, equipment, specimens, and team communication.



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## **Surgical Site Infection**

Infection involving the incision, organ, or operative space within the surveillance period after surgery. It may be superficial incisional, deep incisional, or organ-space and requires appropriate culture, antimicrobial therapy, drainage, debridement, or reoperation when indicated.

## **Surgical Time-Out**

A deliberate team pause immediately before incision to verify patient identity, procedure, site, consent, allergies, antibiotics, imaging, implants, equipment, and anticipated critical events. It is a core surgical-safety intervention.

## **Surgical Wound Classification**

Categorization of an operative wound as clean, clean-contaminated, contaminated, or dirty/infected according to the degree of microbial exposure and existing infection. The class helps estimate surgical-site infection risk and guide prophylaxis.

## **Surrogate Decision-Maker**

A person authorized to make healthcare decisions for someone who lacks decision-making capacity, guided by the person's known values and preferences.

## **Surveillance**

Systematic collection, analysis, interpretation of health data. Types: passive (reporting), active (proactive case finding), sentinel (selected sites).

## **Surveillance Imaging**

Repeat imaging to detect recurrence. Protocol varies by cancer type, stage, treatment.

## **Survival Rate**

Percentage of patients surviving for specified time after diagnosis. 5-year survival commonly used.

## **Survivorship**

Care for cancer survivors. Addresses late effects, surveillance, quality of life.

## **Survivorship Care Plan**

Document summarizing treatment, follow-up, late effects. Provided to cancer survivors.

## **Susac Syndrome**

An autoimmune microangiopathy affecting the brain, retina, and inner ear. The characteristic triad is encephalopathy, branch retinal-artery occlusions, and sensorineural hearing loss, though all features may not be present initially.

## **Susceptibility Testing**

Laboratory tests determining the sensitivity of a bacterial isolate to antimicrobials to guide therapy. Methods: disk diffusion (Kirby-Bauer—zone sizes), broth dilution (MIC—minimum inhibitory concentration, MBC—minimum bactericidal concentration), E-test (gradient strips), and automated systems (VITEK).

## **Suspected Cause**

A condition or factor believed to explain a disease or symptom but not yet confirmed.

## **Suspension**

A pharmaceutical formulation in which fine solid drug particles are dispersed (not dissolved) in a liquid vehicle, often with suspending agents and stabilizers. Suspensions are used when a drug is poorly soluble, for oral (antibiotic suspensions, antacids), topical, ophthalmic, and parenteral (depot) administration.

## **Suture (Perineal)**

A thread or strand of material used to approximate tissues (bring wound edges together) and hold them in place until healing occurs. See Suture.

### **Synonyms:**

Perineal

## **Suture Anchor**

A small implant that secures a tendon, ligament, or other soft tissue to bone. It may be made from metal, polymer, or bioabsorbable material and can fail through pullout, breakage, migration, or inflam-

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matory reaction.

### **SUV**

Standardized uptake value, a semiquantitative measure of radiotracer concentration used mainly in PET imaging.

### **SVC Syndrome**

Obstruction of the superior vena cava causing facial swelling, plethora, and distended neck veins. Commonly from lung cancer (SCLC, squamous) and lymphoma. Oncologic emergency.

### **Swallow Study**

X-ray imaging of swallowing using barium. Evaluates dysphagia, aspiration, structural abnormalities.

### **Swallowing**

Difficulty swallowing, classified as oropharyngeal (difficulty initiating a swallow, choking, coughing, nasal regurgitation) or esophageal (sensation of food sticking retrosternally). See dysphagia.

#### **Synonyms:**

Difficulty Swallowing (Swallowing)

### **Swallowing Assessment**

Clinical and, when indicated, instrumental evaluation of oral, pharyngeal, and esophageal swallowing to identify dysphagia, aspiration, and appropriate food or liquid consistency. Videofluoroscopic or endoscopic studies may be required when bedside assessment is insufficient.

### **Swallowing Therapy**

Assessment and treatment to improve the safety and efficiency of swallowing and reduce aspiration risk.

### **Sweat Chloride Test**

A test that measures chloride concentration in sweat after pilocarpine stimulation. It is an important diagnostic test for cystic fibrosis, but results must be interpreted with the clinical findings and, when needed, genetic or other testing. Some illnesses and technical factors can produce misleading results.

### **Sweat Gland**

A skin gland that produces sweat, which contributes mainly to temperature regulation and skin surface function.

### **Sweating**

Production of sweat by eccrine and apocrine glands for heat regulation and other responses; excessive, absent, or asymmetric sweating can indicate medication, autonomic, endocrine, or neurologic disease.

### **Sweet Syndrome**

An inflammatory skin disorder characterized by sudden fever and tender red or violaceous plaques or nodules containing many neutrophils. It may be associated with infection, medicines, inflammatory disease, or cancer.

### **Sweet's Syndrome**

Acute febrile neutrophilic dermatosis, characterized by fever, neutrophilia, and painful, erythematous plaques or nodules on the skin, histologically showing dense neutrophilic infiltration of the dermis. It may be idiopathic, drug-induced, or associated with malignancy, particularly hematological cancers.

### **Swine Flu**

A contagious respiratory illness caused by influenza A or B viruses, characterized by sudden onset of fever, myalgia, headache, malaise, nonproductive cough, sore throat, and nasal congestion. See Influenza.

### **Swollen Ankles And Swollen Feet**

Enlargement of the ankles or feet caused by injury, venous insufficiency, lymphatic disease, medication, pregnancy, or systemic fluid retention from heart, kidney, or liver disease. Sudden one-sided swelling with pain, redness, warmth, or breathlessness may indicate thrombosis or infection and requires urgent assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ankle Swollen (Swollen Ankles And Swollen Feet)

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## Symblepharon

Adhesion of the palpebral conjunctiva (inner eyelid) to the bulbar conjunctiva or cornea, most commonly resulting from chemical burns, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, ocular cicatricial pemphigoid, or repeated surgical intervention. It restricts eye movement and may require surgical lysis with amniotic membrane or mucous membrane grafting.

## Sympatholytic

An agent that blocks the sympathetic nervous system, used to treat hypertension, sympathetic overactivity, and catecholamine excess. Classes: beta-blockers (propranolol, metoprolol), alpha-blockers (prazosin, doxazosin, phenoxybenzamine), centrally acting agents (clonidine, methyldopa), and neuron blockers (reserpine, guanethidine).

## Synaptic Plasticity

Activity-dependent change in the strength or structure of synaptic transmission. Long-term potentiation and long-term depression are important cellular mechanisms underlying learning, memory, adaptation, and some forms of chronic pain.

## Synaptic Transmission

The fundamental process by which neurons communicate with each other through specialized junctions called synapses.

## Syncope (Fainting)

A transient loss of consciousness and postural tone caused by temporary global cerebral hypoperfusion, followed by spontaneous recovery. Reflex, orthostatic, and cardiac causes are common; prolonged confusion suggests a different diagnosis. See Fainting.

### Synonyms:

Fainting

## Syndrome Of Inappropriate ADH Secretion

Excessive antidiuretic hormone activity causing eu-volemic hyponatremia with inappropriately concentrated urine and elevated urinary sodium.

## Syndrome Surveillance

The public health monitoring of pre-diagnostic clinical indicators (symptoms, syndromes—fever, rash, GI illness, influenza-like illness) in real time to detect outbreaks, bioterrorism, or emerging infections earlier than laboratory confirmation.

## Syndromic Surveillance

Monitoring of symptoms, clinical encounters, laboratory requests, or other near-real-time signals before definitive diagnoses are available. It supports early detection of outbreaks and public-health threats but may have lower specificity.

## Synovial Chondromatosis

A benign, metaplastic condition characterized by the formation of multiple cartilaginous loose bodies within joint synovium, bursae, or tendon sheaths. It presents with joint pain, swelling, locking, and restricted range of motion, most commonly affecting the knee, hip, and elbow.

## Synovial Fluid Analysis

Laboratory examination of aspirated joint fluid for appearance, viscosity, leukocyte count and differential, crystals under polarized light, Gram stain, and culture. It helps distinguish noninflammatory, inflammatory, crystal-associated, and septic arthritis.

## Synovial Sarcoma

A soft tissue sarcoma typically arising near joints of the extremities in young adults, characterized by the t(X;18) chromosomal translocation.

## Synovography

Contrast imaging of joint cavity. Evaluates synovial pathology.

## Synthesis Module

Automated system for radiopharmaceutical preparation. PET tracer synthesis: FDG, Florbetapir. Quality control: radiochemical purity, pH, sterility.

## Syphilitic Alopecia

Non-scarring hair loss occurring as a manifestation

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of secondary syphilis, presenting with diffuse thinning or patchy, moth-eaten alopecia of the scalp, eyebrows, or beard. It is thought to result from direct spirochaetal invasion of hair follicles during the spirochaetaemic phase.

### Syphilitic Gumma

A destructive, granulomatous lesion occurring in tertiary syphilis, characterized by a center of necrotic tissue surrounded by plasma cells, lymphocytes, and fibroblasts. Gummas may affect any organ, most commonly the skin, bones, liver, and central nervous system. They present as painless, firm nodules that may ulcerate.

### Syrinx

A syrinx is a fluid-filled cavity within the spinal cord, typically containing cerebrospinal fluid or a similar fluid, that develops as a result of abnormal CSF flow dynamics within the spinal cord. Syringomyelia: a syrinx in the central spinal cord. Hydromyelia: dilation of the central canal.

### Systematic Review

Comprehensive summary of research on specific question. Uses explicit methods to minimize bias. Cochrane reviews example.

### Systemic Antifungals

Antifungal medicines taken orally or given intravenously for infections that are extensive, invasive, refractory, or unsuitable for topical treatment. Choice and duration depend on the organism, site, severity, drug interactions, organ function, and local resistance patterns.

### Systemic Effects

Whole-body effects of toxins. Cardiac, neurological, renal, hepatic, hematological.

### Systemic Inflammatory Response Syndrome

A systemic inflammatory response that may occur with infection, trauma, burns, pancreatitis, surgery, or other insults. It can involve abnormal temperature, heart rate, respiratory rate, or white-cell count.

Modern sepsis assessment uses broader clinical criteria rather than SIRS alone.

### Systemic Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis

A subtype of juvenile idiopathic arthritis with prominent systemic inflammation—daily spiking fevers, evanescent salmon-pink rash, arthritis, lymphadenopathy, hepatosplenomegaly, and elevated inflammatory markers (ferritin).

### Systemic Lupus Erythematosus

Multisystem autoimmune disease, more common in women. Features: malar rash, photosensitivity, oral ulcers, arthritis, serositis, renal disorder, neurologic disorder, hematologic disorder, immunologic disorder. Diagnosis: ANA positive plus clinical/immunologic criteria.

### Systemic Sclerosis

Systemic sclerosis, also known as scleroderma, is a chronic autoimmune disease characterized by progressive fibrosis of the skin and internal organs, vasculopathy, and immune dysfunction.

#### Synonyms:

scleroderma, is a chronic autoimmune disease.

### Systemic Therapy

Treatment that reaches the whole body, including chemotherapy, endocrine therapy, targeted therapy, and immunotherapy, as opposed to local therapies such as surgery and radiation.

### Systemic Vascular Resistance

The resistance to blood flow offered by the systemic circulation, determined mainly by arteriolar tone. It is calculated from the pressure gradient across the systemic circulation and cardiac output and is a major determinant of arterial pressure.

### Systolic Murmurs

Murmurs occurring between S1 and S2. Ejection systolic murmurs (crescendo-decrescendo) are caused by flow across semilunar valves (aortic stenosis, pulmonary stenosis) or increased flow across normal valves.

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### Sézary Syndrome

The leukemic variant of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma, characterized by erythroderma, lymphadenopathy, pruritus, and circulating atypical lymphocytes (Sézary cells).

### Sclerosing Peritonitis

Thickening and scarring of the peritoneum that can restrict movement of the intestines.

### Sjogren's Syndrome

An autoimmune disease that commonly causes dry eyes and dry mouth by damaging tear- and saliva-producing glands.

#### Synonyms:

Arthritis Sjogrens Syndrome (Sjogren's Syndrome)

### Staghorn Calculi

Large branching kidney stones that fill part or all of the renal collecting system.

### Sunstroke

A life-threatening form of heat illness in which body temperature rises dangerously high and the nervous system is impaired.

### Systemic Mastocytosis

A disorder in which excessive mast cells accumulate in one or more organs and release inflammatory chemicals.

### Semi-Fowler Position

A semiupright position in which the head and upper body are elevated about 30 to 45 degrees.

### Sitting Position

An upright or semiupright position in which the patient's torso is elevated and the hips and knees are flexed; it is used for selected shoulder and neurosurgical procedures.

### Supine Position

A position in which the patient lies on the back with the face upward; it is the most commonly used surgical position.

### Sacral Dimple

A small indentation in the skin over the lower spine that is present at birth.

#### Synonyms:

Pilonidal Dimple

### Salmonella Infection

An intestinal infection caused by Salmonella bacteria, usually acquired through contaminated food or water.

### Schwannomatosis

A disorder in which multiple schwannomas, tumors of nerve-sheath cells, develop.

#### Synonyms:

Neurinomatosis

### Sclerosing Mesenteritis

A rare inflammatory and fibrotic disorder affecting the mesentery, the tissue supporting the intestines.

### Scorpion Sting

A venomous injury caused by a scorpion, producing local pain and sometimes systemic toxicity.

#### Synonyms:

Stings, Scorpion

### Scrotal Masses

Abnormal lumps or swellings in the tissues of the scrotum.

### Sebaceous Carcinoma

An uncommon skin cancer arising from oil-producing sebaceous glands.

### Secondary Hypertension

High blood pressure caused by another medical condition or by a medication.

### Selective IgA Deficiency

An immune disorder characterized by very low or absent immunoglobulin A levels.

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### **Sex Headaches**

Headaches triggered by sexual activity, including orgasm.

### **Sexually Transmitted Diseases**

Infections transmitted primarily through sexual contact; also called sexually transmitted infections.

#### **Synonyms:**

sexually transmitted infections.

### **Sezary Syndrome**

An uncommon form of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma involving widespread red skin and abnormal lymphocytes in the blood.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sezary Disease

### **Sinus Rhythm**

The normal heart rhythm generated by electrical impulses from the sinoatrial node.

### **Surgical Drill**

A powered instrument used to cut, shape, or bore bone during surgery.

### **Surgical Stapler**

A device that places metal or absorbable staples to close skin, tissue, or a hollow organ.

### **Schwann Cells**

Glial cells of the peripheral nervous system that form myelin around many axons and support the repair and maintenance of peripheral nerves.

### **Scintigraphy**

Nuclear medicine imaging in which a radiotracer is administered and its distribution is recorded to evaluate the structure or function of an organ.

### **Senile Lentigines**

Flat, sharply defined brown or tan spots caused by chronic ultraviolet exposure, commonly appearing on sun-exposed skin with age.

### **Sensory Neuron**

A nerve cell that carries information from sensory receptors toward the central nervous system.

### **Sensory Receptors**

Specialized cells or nerve endings that detect stimuli such as touch, temperature, pain, light, sound, or chemical changes.

### **Sentinel Node Biopsy**

Removal and examination of the first lymph node or nodes to which a tumor is likely to spread, used to assess regional metastasis.

### **Semilunar Valves**

The aortic and pulmonary valves, which open during ventricular contraction and close during ventricular relaxation to prevent backflow into the ventricles.

### **Single-Photon Emission Computed Tomography**

A nuclear medicine imaging technique that detects gamma rays from an injected radiotracer to create cross-sectional images of organ function and blood flow.

### **Simmonds Disease**

An uncommon form of hypopituitarism caused by inadequate pituitary hormone production, often resulting in fatigue, weight loss, low blood pressure, and impaired endocrine function.

### **Skin Turgor**

The skin's ability to return to its normal position after being gently pinched. Reduced turgor may occur with dehydration, although it is less reliable in older adults.

### **Slit-Lamp Biomicroscope**

An instrument that provides a magnified, illuminated view of the eye, especially the cornea, anterior chamber, iris, lens, and conjunctiva.

### **Somatotropin**

Growth hormone, a pituitary hormone that pro-



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motes growth and influences protein, fat, and carbohydrate metabolism.

### **Sphincter Of Oddi**

A muscular valve controlling the flow of bile and pancreatic secretions into the duodenum.

### **Spinal Cavity**

The posterior body cavity formed by the vertebral column that contains and protects the spinal cord.

### **Spiral Organ**

The organ of Corti, a sensory structure in the cochlea containing hair cells that convert sound vibrations into nerve signals.

### **Spirogram**

A graphical record of air volumes and flow during pulmonary function testing.

### **Splenic Flexure**

The bend of the colon where the transverse colon becomes the descending colon, near the spleen.

### **Split-Thickness Skin Graft**

A graft containing the epidermis and part of the dermis, used to cover wounds or burns and allowing the donor site to heal from remaining skin structures.

### **Spondee**

A two-syllable test word with equal emphasis on both syllables, used in speech audiometry.

### **Spondylolysis**

A stress fracture or defect in the pars interarticularis of a vertebral arch, most often in the lower lumbar spine.

### **Staging**

Assessment of the extent of cancer, including the size of the primary tumor, lymph-node involvement, and distant metastases.

### **Stapedius**

A small middle-ear muscle that helps limit move-

ment of the stapes and may protect the inner ear from loud sounds.

### **Stapling**

Closure or joining of tissue with surgical staples.

### **Steroid Hormones**

Lipid-soluble hormones derived from cholesterol, including cortisol, aldosterone, estrogen, progesterone, and testosterone.

### **Stimulants**

Stimulants increase activity in the central nervous system or sympathetic system and may improve alertness but can cause insomnia, anxiety, dependence, or cardiovascular effects.

### **Stress Incontinence**

Involuntary leakage of urine during activities that increase intra-abdominal pressure, such as coughing, sneezing, lifting, or exercise.

### **Stress Injuries**

Tissue injuries caused by repeated loading or overuse without sufficient recovery. Examples include stress fractures, tendinopathy, and muscle strain.

### **Stress Tests**

Diagnostic tests that assess organ function under controlled physical, pharmacologic, or physiologic stress, commonly evaluating the heart for inducible ischemia or abnormal rhythm.

### **Striae Atrophicae**

Linear bands of thin, wrinkled skin caused by stretching and disruption of dermal connective tissue; commonly called stretch marks.

#### **Synonyms:**

stretch marks.

### **Student's Elbow**

Olecranon bursitis, an inflammation of the bursa over the point of the elbow, often related to repeated pressure or trauma.

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### **Subacute Bacterial Endocarditis**

A slowly progressive infection of the endocardium or heart valves, usually caused by less-virulent bacteria and often involving previously abnormal valves.

### **Subcutaneous Layer**

The layer of tissue beneath the dermis, composed mainly of fat and connective tissue. It insulates the body, stores energy, and contains larger vessels and nerves.

### **Surgical Fixation**

Stabilization of a bone, joint, or other structure with devices such as plates, screws, rods, wires, or external frames.

### **Sympathectomy**

Surgical interruption or destruction of sympathetic nerves to reduce abnormal vasoconstriction, sweating, or pain in selected conditions.

### **Symphysis Pubis**

The fibrocartilaginous joint connecting the left and right pubic bones at the front of the pelvis.

### **Synechia**

An abnormal adhesion between adjacent tissues, especially between parts of the iris or between the iris and the lens or cornea.

### **Synovial Fluid**

A viscous fluid within a synovial joint that lubricates articular surfaces and helps nourish cartilage.

### **Synovial Joint**

A freely movable joint in which the articulating bones are separated by a fluid-filled joint cavity enclosed by a capsule.

### **Systemic Circuit**

The circulation that carries oxygenated blood from the left ventricle through the body and returns deoxygenated blood to the right atrium.

### **Salter-Harris Fracture**

A fracture involving the growth plate of a child or adolescent. Types I through V describe progressively different patterns and risks to bone growth.

### **Sternotomy**

Surgical division of the sternum, usually along the midline, to provide access to the heart or mediastinal structures.

### **Serrated Polyposis Syndrome**

A disorder characterized by multiple serrated lesions or polyps in the colon and an increased risk of colorectal cancer, requiring colonoscopic surveillance and removal of significant lesions.

### **Staphylococcal Scalded Skin Syndrome**

A toxin-mediated skin disorder caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*, usually affecting infants or young children and producing widespread superficial blistering and peeling of the skin.

### **Stent Restenosis**

Re-narrowing of a blood vessel within or adjacent to a previously placed stent, usually caused by tissue growth, recurrent atherosclerosis, or thrombosis.

### **Status Migrainosus**

A severe migraine attack that persists for more than 72 hours and may require urgent medical treatment, especially when dehydration, vomiting, or medication overuse is present.

### **Subclinical Hypothyroidism**

A condition with an elevated thyroid-stimulating hormone level and normal circulating free thyroid-hormone levels, often without symptoms or with only mild nonspecific symptoms.

### **Syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone**

Excessive release or effect of antidiuretic hormone causing impaired free-water excretion, low serum sodium, and inappropriately concentrated urine in the absence of an appropriate physiologic stimulus.

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## Sclerotherapy

A treatment in which an irritating or closing agent is injected into a blood vessel or body cavity to make it scar and seal, commonly used for varicose veins and selected vascular lesions.

## Sleep Apnoea

Repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep, most commonly because of upper-airway obstruction or less commonly inadequate respiratory drive.

## Strangulated Hernia

A hernia in which the blood supply to the trapped tissue is cut off, causing ischaemia and possible tissue death; it is a surgical emergency.

## Subdural Haematoma

Accumulation of blood between the dura mater and arachnoid membrane, usually caused by tearing of bridging veins after head injury and sometimes developing gradually.

## S Phase

S phase is the part of the cell cycle during which DNA is replicated so each daughter cell can receive a complete genome.

## Sabarubicin

Sabarubicin is an investigational anthracycline-like antineoplastic drug studied for cytotoxic effects against cancer cells.

## Saccade

A saccade is a rapid, conjugate eye movement that shifts gaze from one target to another.

## Saccharomyces Cerevisiae

*Saccharomyces cerevisiae* is a budding yeast used in baking, brewing, biotechnology, and some probiotic products; it can rarely cause invasive fungemia or other infection in vulnerable patients.

## Saccular Aneurysm

A rounded pouch protruding from one side of an

artery because of focal wall weakness, with rupture and clot formation risks determined by location, size, and growth.

## Sacral Fistula

A sacral fistula is an abnormal tract near the sacrum that may connect skin with deeper tissue and can reflect congenital disease, infection, or pilonidal disease.

## Sacral Region

The lower back and posterior pelvic region overlying the sacrum, a fused triangular bone that connects the lumbar spine with the pelvis.

## Sacral Vertebra

One of the fused vertebrae forming the sacrum, which supports the spine, joins the pelvic bones, and transmits trunk weight to the lower limbs.

## Sacroccygeal Teratoma

A congenital tumor arising at the base of the spine and containing tissues from multiple germ layers; large fetal lesions can cause high-output heart failure or hydrops.

## Sad Mood

Sad mood is a feeling of unhappiness or low mood that may be a normal response or a symptom of depression, grief, illness, or another condition.

## S-Adenosylmethionine

SAMe, a methyl-group donor involved in neurotransmitter, phospholipid, DNA, and other biochemical reactions and studied as a supplement for selected mood, liver, or pain conditions.

## Safety

Safety is protection from preventable harm and includes identifying hazards, reducing risk, using equipment correctly, and responding promptly to danger.

## Safety Study

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to inves-

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tigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### **Safflower Oil**

Safflower oil is a vegetable oil rich in unsaturated fatty acids, used as food or in products; its health effect depends on amount and dietary substitution.

### **Safingol**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called safingol. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Safrole**

Safrole is a natural aromatic compound found in some plants and oils; high or prolonged exposure is toxic and has carcinogenic concern.

### **Sagopilone**

A medical term referring to sagopilone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Salivary Gland Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving salivary gland neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Salmonella Arizonae**

salmonella arizonae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Choleraesuis**

salmonella choleraesuis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Enterica**

salmonella enterica is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Gallinarum**

salmonella gallinarum is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Pullorum**

salmonella pullorum is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Typhi**

salmonella typhi is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Typhimurium**

salmonella typhimurium is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Typhisuis**

salmonella typhisuis is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salmonella Vaccines**

salmonella vaccines is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### **Salt Gland**

A specialized gland in some marine animals and birds that excretes concentrated salt to maintain fluid and electrolyte balance; humans do not possess a comparable salt gland.

### **Sample Fixation**

Preservation of a tissue or cell sample with a chemical or physical method, such as formalin fixation, to

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prevent decay and maintain microscopic structure for processing and staining.

### **Sample Size**

Sample size is the number of observations or participants in a study or test and affects precision, statistical power, and generalizability.

### **Sanitation**

Public-health measures that safely manage human waste, water, food, hygiene, and environmental contamination to prevent infection and disease transmission.

### **Sapovirus**

sapovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Sapporo Virus**

sapporo virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Sapropterin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called sapropterin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Saquinavir**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called saquinavir. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Saquinavir Mesylate**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called saquinavir mesylate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Saracatinib**

A medical term referring to saracatinib. Its clinical

meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Saralasin**

Saralasin is an investigational angiotensin-receptor antagonist formerly used to study renin–angiotensin physiology and blood-pressure regulation.

### **Sarcocystis**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcocystis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcocystis Hominis**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcocystis hominis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcocystis Suihominis**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcocystis sui hominis. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcocystosis**

Parasitic infection by Sarcocystis species, acquired from undercooked meat or contaminated food and sometimes causing muscle pain, fever, diarrhea, or no symptoms.

### **Sarcoglycan Complex**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcoglycan complex. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcomere**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcomere. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcoplasm**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcoplasm. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcoplasmic Reticulum**

A biological or biochemical term involving sarcoplas-

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mic reticulum. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Sarcosine**

Sarcosine is a naturally occurring amino-acid derivative involved in one-carbon metabolism and studied in neurologic and psychiatric research.

### **Sarcosinemia**

An uncommon metabolic finding with elevated sarcosine in blood or urine, usually due to altered glycine metabolism and often without major clinical symptoms.

### **Sardomozide**

Sardomozide is an investigational compound studied for anticancer activity through effects on cellular growth and survival.

### **Sargramostim**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called sargramostim. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **SARS Virus**

SARS virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Satellite DNA**

A biological or biochemical term involving satellite dna. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Satellite Virus**

satellite virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Satiation**

The feeling of fullness that terminates a meal, produced by gastrointestinal stretch, nutrients, hor-

mones, and brain signals regulating food intake.

### **Satisfaction**

A person's evaluation of how well an experience, service, treatment, or outcome met expectations; in healthcare it is one quality measure but does not replace clinical outcomes or safety.

### **Satraplatin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called satraplatin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Saturated Phytosterol**

A biological or biochemical term involving saturated phytosterol. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Saxitoxin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving saxitoxin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Scaffold Seeding**

A biological or biochemical term involving scaffold seeding. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Scan Gallium**

A nuclear-medicine scan using radiolabeled gallium to identify areas of inflammation, infection, or some tumors; uptake is interpreted with anatomy and clinical context.

### **Scanning**

Systematic examination of a body region or specimen using imaging, microscopy, or another detection method to locate, characterize, or monitor abnormalities.

### **Scanning Electron Microscopy**

Microscopy that scans a focused electron beam across a specimen surface to produce a high-resolution image of its three-dimensional topography



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and composition.

### **Scaphoid Abdomen**

A scaphoid abdomen is an unusually hollowed abdominal contour, classically seen with severe diaphragmatic hernia in a newborn but also possible with marked wasting.

### **Scaphoid Bone**

The largest proximal-row carpal bone on the thumb side of the wrist; its waist is vulnerable to fracture and avascular necrosis because of its blood supply.

### **Scaphycephaly**

Scaphycephaly is a long, narrow skull shape caused by premature fusion of the sagittal suture and may require evaluation for craniosynostosis.

### **Scavenger Receptor**

A cell-surface or intracellular receptor that binds and removes modified lipids, debris, microbes, or dying cells and contributes to innate immunity and atherosclerosis.

### **Scedosporium**

A medical term referring to scedosporium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Scedosporium Apiospermum**

A medical term referring to scedosporium apiospermum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Scedosporium Prolifican**

A medical term referring to scedosporium prolifican. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Schaalia Radingae**

A medical term referring to schaalia radingae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Schaalia Turicensis**

A medical term referring to schaalia turicensis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Scheduled Notification**

A planned alert or message delivered at a specified time to remind a person about an appointment, medicine, monitoring task, or health-related action.

### **Schiff Base**

A medical term referring to schiff base. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Schiller Test**

A cervical examination using iodine solution; glycogen-rich normal squamous epithelium stains dark, while iodine-negative areas require clinical correlation and sometimes biopsy.

### **Schistocyte Count**

Measurement of fragmented red blood cells on a blood smear, supporting evaluation of microangiopathic hemolysis, mechanical valve damage, disseminated intravascular coagulation, or severe burns.

### **Schistosoma**

A medical term referring to schistosoma. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Schistosoma Intercalatum**

A medical term referring to schistosoma intercalatum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Scolecobasidium Terreum**

A medical term referring to scolecobasidium terreum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Scopolamine**

Scopolamine is a muscarinic antagonist used mainly to prevent motion sickness and postoperative nausea; dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, confusion, and other anticholinergic effects may oc-

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cur.

### Scopolamine Hydrobromide

A biological or biochemical term involving scopolamine hydrobromide. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Scopoletin

A medical term referring to scopoletin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Scopulariopsis

Scopulariopsis is a mold genus that rarely causes opportunistic infection, especially in people with immune suppression or implanted devices.

### Scrapie

Scrapie is a fatal prion disease of sheep and goats causing progressive neurologic dysfunction; it is not considered a usual human infection.

### Screening Procedure

A test or examination offered to people without symptoms to detect disease or risk early enough for effective prevention or treatment; eligibility and intervals depend on evidence and risk.

### Screening Study

A planned investigation of an asymptomatic population to identify early disease, precursor lesions, or risk factors using a validated test and follow-up pathway.

### Sea-Blue Histiocyte

A sea-blue histiocyte is a macrophage containing blue-green lipid or ceroid pigment on staining, seen in some storage, hematologic, or metabolic disorders.

### Sebaceous Adenoma

A sebaceous adenoma is a usually benign tumor of sebaceous glands that can appear as a yellowish skin nodule and may be associated with Muir-Torre syndrome.

### Sebaceous Gland Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving sebaceous gland carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Secondary Amenorrhea

Absence of menstruation for at least three months in someone with previously regular cycles or six months with previously irregular cycles, caused by pregnancy, endocrine, ovarian, uterine, or systemic factors.

### Secondary Hypothyroidism

Low thyroid hormone production caused by inadequate pituitary TSH stimulation, usually from pituitary or hypothalamic disease; TSH may be low, normal, or inappropriately mildly high.

### Secondary Metabolism

Biochemical pathways that produce specialized compounds not required for basic growth but important for defense, signaling, pigmentation, or interactions with the environment.

### Second-Look Surgery

second-look surgery is used in relation to second-look surgery during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### Sign Language

Sign language is a complete visual language using hand shape, movement, position, facial expression, and body movement rather than spoken sound.

### Signal Peptide

signal peptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in signal peptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### Silent Mutation

A DNA sequence change that does not alter the encoded amino acid, usually because of genetic-code redundancy, although it can sometimes affect splicing, RNA stability, or translation.

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### Silicate

A medical term referring to silicate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silicon Dioxide

Silicon dioxide is a mineral found in dust and industrial materials; inhalation of crystalline forms can cause silicosis and increase lung-cancer risk.

### Silicone

A medical term referring to silicone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silicone Elastomer

A medical term referring to silicone elastomer. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silk

Silk is a protein fiber used in textiles and some medical sutures or biomaterials; reactions and tissue response depend on the product and processing.

### Siltuximab

A medical term referring to siltuximab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silver

A medical term referring to silver. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silver Nitrate

A medical term referring to silver nitrate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silver Sulfadiazine

A medical term referring to silver sulfadiazine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Silymarin

A medical term referring to silymarin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Simeprevir

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called simeprevir. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### Simethicone

Simethicone is a non-absorbed antifoaming agent that coalesces gas bubbles in the gastrointestinal tract and is used for symptomatic relief of bloating; it does not treat the underlying cause of pain.

### Simian Virus 40

simian virus 40 is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Simple Mastectomy

simple mastectomy is used in relation to simple mastectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### Simplexvirus

simplexvirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Simuliidae

A medical term referring to simuliidae. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Simultanagnosia

Simultanagnosia is inability to perceive more than one object or the overall visual scene at a time, usually from dysfunction of visual-association regions.

### Sincalide

A medical term referring to sincalide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Sindbis Virus

sindbis virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission,

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tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Sinecatechins**

A medical term referring to sinecatechins. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Singlet Oxygen**

A medical term referring to singlet oxygen. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sinuatrial Node**

A medical term referring to sinuatrial node. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sinus Arrhythmia**

Sinus arrhythmia is normal variation in sinus-heart rate, commonly speeding during inhalation and slowing during exhalation, especially in young people.

### **Sinus Bradycardia**

Sinus bradycardia is a sinus rhythm slower than the expected rate; it can be normal during sleep or athletic conditioning but may also reflect drugs or disease.

### **Sinus Histiocytosis**

Expansion of lymph-node sinuses by histiocytes, often a reactive response to drainage of inflammation, infection, tumor, or tissue breakdown; interpretation depends on associated findings.

### **Siplizumab**

A medical term referring to siplizumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sipuleucel-T**

A medical term referring to sipuleucel-t. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sirolimus**

Sirolimus is an mTOR inhibitor used for immunosuppression after transplantation and selected vas-

cular or lymphatic disorders; mouth ulcers, hyperlipidaemia, cytopenias, infection, impaired wound healing, and pneumonitis can occur.

### **Sisomicin**

A medical term referring to sisomicin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sitagliptin Phosphate**

Sitagliptin phosphate is a DPP-4 inhibitor that prolongs incretin activity and improves glucose-dependent insulin secretion in type 2 diabetes; dose adjustment in kidney disease and rare pancreatitis or severe joint pain are important considerations.

### **Site-Directed Mutagenesis**

A laboratory method that introduces a planned nucleotide change at a selected DNA site to study gene function, protein structure, regulation, or disease variants.

### **Sitosterols**

Sitosterols are plant sterols that resemble cholesterol and reduce intestinal cholesterol absorption; rare inherited storage disorders cause excessive accumulation.

### **Situs Ambiguus**

Situs ambiguus is abnormal, inconsistent arrangement of internal organs along the left-right body axis and is often associated with congenital heart and splenic abnormalities.

### **Size Perception**

The sensory judgment of an object's dimensions, influenced by visual context, distance, depth cues, touch, and brain processing; neurologic or visual disease can distort it.

### **Sizofiran**

Sizofiran is an investigational beta-glucan immunomodulator studied as an adjunct to cancer treatment.

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## Skeletal Development

Skeletal development is formation, growth, remodeling, and maturation of bones and cartilage from embryonic life through adulthood.

## Skeletal Dysplasia

A skeletal dysplasia is an inherited disorder of bone or cartilage growth causing disproportionate short stature, abnormal limbs, spine disease, or other skeletal features.

## Skeletal Muscle Tissue

Voluntary striated muscle attached to bones or other structures, composed of contractile fibers that generate movement, posture, heat, and joint stability.

## Skeletal Myocytes

Skeletal myocytes are striated muscle cells responsible for voluntary movement, posture, heat production, and stabilization of joints.

## Skeletal System

The skeletal system consists of bones, cartilage, joints, and supporting ligaments that provide structure, protect organs, enable movement, and store minerals.

## Skin Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving skin carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Skin Care

Measures that protect and maintain the skin, including gentle cleansing, moisturization, sun protection, wound care, avoidance of irritants, and treatment of identified disease.

## Skin Erosion

A shallow loss of the epidermis that leaves a moist or crusted surface but does not extend deeply into the dermis, often caused by friction, scratching, blister rupture, or inflammation.

## Skin Examination

Systematic inspection and palpation of the skin, hair, nails, and mucous membranes to assess color, lesions, texture, distribution, vascular signs, infection, and cancer warning features.

## Skin Induration

Abnormal hardening or firmness of skin or underlying tissue caused by fibrosis, inflammation, edema, infiltrative disease, infection, or tumor.

## Skin Mastocytoma

A localized collection of mast cells in the skin, usually a yellow-brown or reddish plaque or nodule in a child that may swell, itch, or redden when rubbed.

## Skin Necrosis

Death of skin tissue from ischemia, infection, pressure, toxins, trauma, vasculitis, or severe inflammation, producing discoloration, blisters, ulcers, or black eschar.

## Skin Neoplasm

A neoplasm involving skin neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Spinal Artery

An artery supplying the spinal cord and its coverings, including the anterior spinal artery and paired posterior spinal arteries; blockage can cause characteristic neurologic deficits.

## Spinal Block

A spinal block is injection of local anesthetic into cerebrospinal fluid in the lower back, producing temporary numbness and weakness for surgery or pain control.

## Spinal Canal

The spinal canal is the bony passage through the vertebral column containing the spinal cord, its coverings, nerve roots, and blood vessels.

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### Spinal Cord Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving spinal cord disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Spinal Cord Neoplasms

A neoplasm involving spinal cord neoplasms. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Spinal Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving spinal disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Spinal Fracture

A clinical condition or finding involving spinal fracture. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Spinal Ganglion

A cluster of sensory neuron cell bodies, especially a dorsal-root ganglion, carrying signals from skin, muscles, and joints toward the spinal cord.

### Spinal Neoplasms

A neoplasm involving spinal neoplasms. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### Spindle Pole

A spindle pole is one end of the mitotic spindle from which microtubules extend to separate duplicated chromosomes during cell division.

### Spindle Pole Body

The spindle pole body is the microtubule-organizing structure in fungi that functions like a centrosome during nuclear division.

### Spine Injury

A clinical condition or finding involving spine injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Spinocerebellar Ataxia

Spinocerebellar ataxias are inherited neurodegenerative disorders causing progressive incoordination, gait problems, dysarthria, abnormal eye movements, and sometimes other neurologic signs.

### Spiral Colon

A spiral arrangement of the proximal colon described in some animals, especially ruminants, that increases transit length and absorptive surface; it is not a normal human colonic segment.

### Spirillum Minus

Spirillum minus is a spiral Gram-negative bacterium that causes rat-bite fever, characterized by fever, rash, and migratory joint pain after rodent exposure; culture is difficult and diagnosis may be clinical or molecular.

### Spiritual Support

A medical term referring to spiritual support. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Spirochaetaceae

spirochaetaceae is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### Spirochaetales Infection

spirochaetales infection is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### Spitting

Spitting is forceful expulsion of saliva or other material from the mouth; new excessive spitting may reflect oral disease, reflux, nausea, swallowing difficulty, or behavior.

### Splanchnic Nerve

A visceral autonomic nerve carrying sympathetic or parasympathetic fibers from the thorax or abdomen



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to prevertebral ganglia and internal organs.

### **Spleen Development**

Spleen development is the embryonic formation and postnatal maturation of the organ that filters blood, supports immune responses, and removes aged blood cells.

### **Spleen Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving spleen disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Spleen Hemangioma**

A spleen hemangioma is a usually benign blood-vessel tumor of the spleen, often incidental but occasionally associated with enlargement, anemia, or rupture risk.

### **Splenic Abscess**

A localized collection of pus in the spleen, usually from bloodstream infection, trauma, infarction, or spread from nearby disease and potentially causing fever, left-upper-quadrant pain, and sepsis.

### **Splenic Infection**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving splenic infection; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Splenic Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving splenic neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Spliceosome**

The spliceosome is a nuclear RNA-protein complex that removes introns from pre-messenger RNA and joins exons to form mature RNA.

### **Split Brain**

A state after surgical or pathological disruption of the corpus callosum in which information transfer between cerebral hemispheres is reduced, producing

characteristic disconnection findings.

### **Spondylarthritis**

A family of inflammatory rheumatic diseases affecting the spine, sacroiliac joints, entheses, peripheral joints, skin, eyes, or bowel, including ankylosing spondylitis and psoriatic arthritis.

### **Sponge**

A sponge is a porous material used to absorb fluid, clean or dress wounds, or deliver a product; retained surgical sponges are a preventable complication.

### **Spontaneous Abortion**

Pregnancy loss before fetal viability that occurs without intentional intervention, commonly caused by chromosomal abnormalities but also by uterine, endocrine, immune, infectious, or other factors.

### **Spontaneous Perforation**

Unexpected rupture of a hollow organ without a clear external injury, allowing contents to escape and potentially causing peritonitis, mediastinitis, sepsis, or hemorrhage.

### **Sporothrix**

A medical term referring to sporothrix. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sporothrix Schenckii**

A medical term referring to sporothrix schenckii. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Spousal Abuse**

Spousal abuse is physical, sexual, emotional, financial, or coercive harm by an intimate partner; immediate safety planning and confidential support may be needed.

### **Spouse**

A spouse is a person's legally or socially recognized partner; involving a spouse in healthcare requires the patient's consent unless law provides otherwise.

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### Spray Drying

Spray drying converts a liquid mixture into a dry powder by atomizing it into a heated gas stream, often used in pharmaceutical and food manufacturing.

### Spumavirus

spumavirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### Squalamine Lactate

A biological or biochemical term involving squalamine lactate. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### Squalene

A medical term referring to squalene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Square Foot

A square foot is a unit of area equal to a square measuring one foot on each side, used to describe surfaces, rooms, wounds, or treatment areas.

### Square Inch

A square inch is a unit of area equal to a square measuring one inch on each side, used for small surfaces or wound measurements.

### Square Metres

Square metres are units of area equal to the surface of a one-metre square, used in clinical, environmental, and dosage calculations.

### Sscp Analysis

Single-strand conformation polymorphism analysis, a laboratory method that detects some DNA sequence variants by differences in the migration of single-stranded fragments through a gel.

### Symbolism

A medical term referring to symbolism. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Sympathetic Ganglion

A cluster of sympathetic autonomic neuron cell bodies, located in paravertebral or prevertebral chains, that relays signals controlling vessels, sweat glands, viscera, and other targets.

### Symptomatic

A medical term referring to symptomatic. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synapse Assembly

A medical term referring to synapse assembly. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synapsins

A medical term referring to synapsins. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synaptic Cleft

A medical term referring to synaptic cleft. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synaptic Membrane

The specialized membrane at a neuronal junction, including the neurotransmitter-releasing presynaptic membrane and receptor-containing postsynaptic membrane.

### Synaptic Vesicle

A medical term referring to synaptic vesicle. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synaptonemal Complex

A medical term referring to synaptonemal complex. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synaptophysin

A medical term referring to synaptophysin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### Synaptosome

A medical term referring to synaptosome. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synaptotagmin

A medical term referring to synaptotagmin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synarthrosis

A joint with little or no movement, such as a skull suture or tooth anchored in its socket, in which bones are joined by fibrous tissue or cartilage.

### Syncephalastrum

A medical term referring to syncephalastrum. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synchrotron

A synchrotron is a particle accelerator that produces intense beams of charged particles or radiation used in research, imaging, and materials analysis.

### Syndecan

A medical term referring to syndecan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Synesthesia

Synesthesia is a stable perceptual phenomenon in which stimulation of one sensory pathway automatically produces an experience in another, such as seeing colors with sounds.

### Syngeneic

Genetically identical or nearly identical within the same species, as in tissues or cells exchanged between identical twins or inbred laboratory animals.

### Synovial Bursa

A synovial bursa is a small fluid-filled sac that reduces friction between moving tissues near joints, such as tendons, skin, muscles, and bone.

### Synovial Cyst

A synovial cyst is a fluid-filled sac arising from or near a joint or tendon sheath, sometimes compressing nearby nerves and causing pain or weakness.

### Synoviocytes

Synoviocytes are cells lining the joint synovium that produce lubricating fluid and inflammatory mediators and help maintain or damage joint tissue.

### Syntax

Syntax is the arrangement of words, symbols, or genetic sequence elements according to rules that determine meaning and valid structure.

### Synthesis

Synthesis is the biological or chemical production of a complex molecule or structure from simpler components, such as protein synthesis from amino acids or DNA synthesis from nucleotides.

### Synthetic Androgen

A synthetic androgen is a manufactured compound that activates androgen receptors and may mimic testosterone; therapeutic and anabolic use can suppress gonadal function and cause acne, mood effects, infertility, liver injury, or cardiovascular harm.

### Syringoma

A syringoma is a benign tumor of sweat-duct cells, usually appearing as small skin-colored or yellowish papules around the eyelids or elsewhere.

### Syrup

A syrup is a viscous liquid preparation, often sweetened, used as a medicine vehicle or oral dosage form; concentration and ingredients determine safe dosing.

### Systemic Chemotherapy

systemic chemotherapy is used in relation to systemic chemotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### Systemic Disease

A clinical condition or finding involving systemic

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disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Systemic Scleroderma**

Systemic sclerosis, an autoimmune connective-tissue disease causing vascular dysfunction and fibrosis of skin and internal organs, commonly affecting the esophagus, lungs, kidneys, and heart.

### **Systemic Venous**

Systemic venous refers to veins returning deoxygenated blood from the body to the right side of the heart, excluding the pulmonary circulation.

### **Sarcoma, Bone Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Bone cancer*.

### **Sarcoma, Soft Tissue**

Alternate index label; see *Soft tissue sarcoma*.

### **SBBO**

Alternate index label; see *Small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO)*.

### **SCAD**

Alternate index label; see *Spontaneous coronary artery dissection (SCAD)*.

### **Scalded Mouth Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Burning mouth syndrome*.

### **Schizophrenia, Adolescent**

Alternate index label; see *Childhood schizophrenia*.

### **Schizophrenia, Childhood**

Alternate index label; see *Childhood schizophrenia*.

### **Schizophrenia, Juvenile**

Alternate index label; see *Childhood schizophrenia*.

### **SCI**

Alternate index label; see *Spinal cord injury*.

### **Sclerosing Cholangitis**

Sclerosing cholangitis is inflammation and scarring that narrows bile ducts, causing cholestasis and sometimes cirrhosis; primary and secondary causes require different evaluation.

### **Sclerosis, Multiple**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple sclerosis*.

### **Sclerosis, Systemic**

Alternate index label; see *Scleroderma*.

### **Seasonal Allergy**

Alternate index label; see *Hay fever*.

### **Sebaceous Cysts**

Alternate index label; see *Epidermoid cysts*.

### **Secondary Brain Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Brain metastases*.

### **SEID**

Alternate index label; see *Myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome (ME/CFS)*.

### **Seizure Disorder**

Alternate index label; see *Epilepsy*.

### **Seizure, Absence**

Alternate index label; see *Absence seizure*.

### **Seizure, Febrile**

Alternate index label; see *Febrile seizure*.

### **Seizure, Grand Mal**

Alternate index label; see *Tonic-clonic (grand mal) seizure*.

### **Seizure, Petit Mal**

Alternate index label; see *Absence seizure*.

### **Seizure, Temporal Lobe**

Alternate index label; see *Temporal lobe seizure*.

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**Self Harming**

Alternate index label; see *Self-injury/cutting*.

**Septal Defect, Atrioventricular**

Alternate index label; see *Atrioventricular canal defect*.

**Septal Defect, Ventricular**

Alternate index label; see *Ventricular septal defect (VSD)*.

**Severe Brain Injury, Coma**

Alternate index label; see *Coma*.

**Sexual Dysfunction, Female**

Alternate index label; see *Female sexual dysfunction*.

**Sexual Obsession**

Alternate index label; see *Compulsive sexual behavior*.

**Sezary Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Sezary syndrome*.

**Shy-Drager Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple system atrophy*.

**SIBO**

Alternate index label; see *Small intestinal bacterial overgrowth (SIBO)*.

**Sin Nombre Virus Infection**

Alternate index label; see *Hantavirus pulmonary syndrome*.

**Sinusitis, Acute**

Alternate index label; see *Acute sinusitis*.

**Sinusitis, Chronic**

Alternate index label; see *Chronic sinusitis*.

**SJS**

Alternate index label; see *Stevens-Johnson syndrome*.

**Skin Cancer, Melanoma**

Alternate index label; see *Melanoma*.

**Skin Writing**

Alternate index label; see *Dermatographia (Dermatographism)*.

**Skin, Itchy**

Alternate index label; see *Itchy skin (pruritus)*.

**Skipped Heartbeats**

Alternate index label; see *Heart palpitations*.

**Slapped Cheek Disease**

Alternate index label; see *Parvovirus infection*.

**Sleep Apnea In Children, Obstructive**

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric obstructive sleep apnea*.

**Sleep Apnea, Central**

Alternate index label; see *Central sleep apnea*.

**Sleep Apnea, Obstructive**

Alternate index label; see *Obstructive sleep apnea*.

**Sleepiness, Daytime**

Alternate index label; see *Narcolepsy*.

**Sleeplessness**

Alternate index label; see *Insomnia*.

**SLL**

Alternate index label; see *Small lymphocytic lymphoma*.

**Slow Heartbeat**

Alternate index label; see *Bradycardia*.

**Small Bowel Bacterial Overgrowth**

Small bowel bacterial overgrowth examines small bowel bacterial overgrowth; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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### **Small Bowel Prolapse**

Alternate index label; see *Small bowel prolapse (enterocele)*.

### **Small Intestine Prolapse**

Alternate index label; see *Small bowel prolapse (enterocele)*.

### **Solar Keratosis**

Alternate index label; see *Actinic keratosis*.

### **Solar Lentigines**

Alternate index label; see *Age spots (liver spots)*.

### **Specific Reading Disability**

Alternate index label; see *Dyslexia*.

### **Spinal Curvature**

Alternate index label; see *Scoliosis*.

### **Spinal Fluid Leak**

Alternate index label; see *CSF leak (Cerebrospinal fluid leak)*.

### **Spondylosis, Cervical**

Alternate index label; see *Cervical spondylosis*.

### **Stage 4 Prostate Cancer**

Alternate index label; see *Metastatic (stage 4) prostate cancer*.

### **STDs**

Alternate index label; see *Sexually transmitted diseases (STDs)*.

### **Steele-Richardson-Olszewski Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Progressive supranuclear palsy*.

### **Stein-Leventhal Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Polyendocrine metabolic ovarian syndrome (PMOS)*.

### **Stenosing Tenosynovitis**

Alternate index label; see *Trigger finger*.

### **Stenosis, Aortic Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Aortic valve stenosis*.

### **Stenosis, Mitral Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Mitral valve stenosis*.

### **Stenosis, Pulmonary Valve**

Alternate index label; see *Pulmonary valve stenosis*.

### **Stenosis, Pyloric**

Alternate index label; see *Pyloric stenosis*.

### **Stenosis, Spinal**

Alternate index label; see *Spinal stenosis*.

### **Stings, Bee**

Alternate index label; see *Bee sting*.

### **Stings, Jellyfish**

Alternate index label; see *Jellyfish stings*.

### **Stings, Scorpion**

Alternate index label; see *Scorpion sting*.

### **Stomach Flu**

Alternate index label; see *Viral gastroenteritis (stomach flu)*.

### **Stomatodynia**

Alternate index label; see *Burning mouth syndrome*.

### **Stool Holding**

Alternate index label; see *Encopresis*.

### **Strawberry Hemangioma**

Alternate index label; see *Hemangioma*.

### **Stump Pain**

Alternate index label; see *Residual limb pain*.



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## Subfertility

Alternate index label; see *Infertility*.

## Substance Abuse Disorder

Alternate index label; see *Drug addiction (substance use disorder)*.

## Sun Poisoning

Alternate index label; see *Polymorphous light eruption*.

## Sunken Chest

Alternate index label; see *Pectus excavatum*.

## Supranuclear Palsy

Alternate index label; see *Progressive supranuclear palsy*.

## SVT

Alternate index label; see *Supraventricular tachycardia*.

## Sweating, Abnormally Excessive

Alternate index label; see *Hyperhidrosis*.

## Swelling

Abnormal enlargement caused by fluid accumulation, inflammation, bleeding, infection, tumor, or tissue injury; location, onset, pain, and associated symptoms identify the likely cause.

## Syndrome X

Alternate index label; see *Metabolic syndrome*.

## Systemic Exertional Intolerance Disease

Alternate index label; see *Myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome (ME/CFS)*.

## Sachet Poisoning

Sachet poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sachet poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Sacroiliac Joint Pain - Aftercare

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to sacroiliac joint pain - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Safe Driving For Teens

Safe driving for teens addresses care related to safe driving for teens, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Safe Eating During Cancer Treatment

Safe eating during cancer treatment addresses care related to safe eating during cancer treatment, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Safe Sex

Safe sex addresses care related to safe sex, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Salads And Nutrients

Salads can provide fiber, vitamins, minerals, and beneficial plant compounds, but nutritional value depends on ingredients, portions, dressings, and overall dietary pattern.

## Saline Nasal Washes

A medical term referring to saline nasal washes. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Salivary Duct Stones

Salivary duct stones examines salivary duct stones; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Salivary Gland Biopsy

Salivary gland biopsy examines salivary gland biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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## Salivary Gland Infections

Salivary gland infections examines salivary gland infections; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Salmonella Enterocolitis

Salmonella enterocolitis is intestinal infection causing diarrhea, fever, abdominal cramps, and sometimes bacteremia after contaminated food, water, or animal exposure.

## Sassafras Oil Overdose

Sassafras oil overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to sassafras oil overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## Satiety - Early

Satiety - early concerns satiety - early, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## Savings Account For Health Care Costs

Savings account for health care costs examines savings account for health care costs; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Scalded Skin Syndrome

A clinical condition involving scalded Skin Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Scales

Scales are flakes or plates of shed skin on the surface, occurring with dryness, eczema, psoriasis, fungal infection, or other dermatologic conditions.

## Scar Revision

A procedure that improves the appearance, contour, flexibility, or symptoms of a scar through excision, rearrangement, grafting, laser, injection, or other selected techniques.

## Schirmer Test

Schirmer test examines schirmer test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## School Age Test Or Procedure Preparation

School age test or procedure preparation examines school age test or procedure preparation; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## School-Age Children Development

School-age development includes advances in growth, coordination, language, learning, independence, social relationships, and emotional regulation, with broad normal variation.

## Scleredema Diabeticorum

A clinical finding or condition involving scleredema Diabeticorum; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

## Scleroderma - Resources

Scleroderma - resources addresses care related to scleroderma - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Scleroma

Scleroma is chronic granulomatous infection, usually of the upper airway, caused by *Klebsiella rhinoscleromatis* and potentially producing scarring and obstruction.

## Scoliosis - Resources

Scoliosis - resources addresses care related to scoliosis - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Scoliosis Surgery In Children

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to scoliosis surgery in children; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the

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specific intervention and patient.

### **Scorpion Fish Sting**

Scorpion fish sting involves toxic or environmental exposure to scorpion fish sting; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Scorpions**

Scorpions involves toxic or environmental exposure to scorpions; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Scrape**

A scrape is a superficial abrasion in which friction removes part of the skin surface; cleaning, protection, and monitoring for infection support healing.

### **Screen Time And Children**

Time children spend using televisions, computers, phones, tablets, or game devices; excessive or poorly timed use can affect sleep, activity, learning, mood, and family routines.

### **Screening And Diagnosis For HIV**

Screening and diagnosis for HIV examines screening and diagnosis for hiv; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Scrotal Swelling**

Enlargement of the scrotum caused by fluid, inflammation, infection, hernia, varicocele, hydrocele, tumor, trauma, or testicular torsion; sudden pain is an emergency.

### **Scrotal Ultrasound**

Scrotal ultrasound examines scrotal ultrasound; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Secobarbital Overdose**

Secobarbital overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to secobarbital overdose; dose, route,

timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Secondary Infections**

Secondary infections examines secondary infections; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Secondary Parkinsonism**

Secondary parkinsonism is slowed movement, rigidity, tremor, or postural instability caused by another condition, medicine, toxin, vascular injury, or structural brain disease.

### **Secondary Systemic Amyloidosis**

Secondary systemic amyloidosis results when chronic inflammation or infection drives production of serum amyloid A, which deposits in organs such as the kidneys, liver, and spleen.

### **Secretin Stimulation Test**

Secretin stimulation test examines secretin stimulation test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Seizures**

Seizures are transient episodes of abnormal excessive brain electrical activity causing changes in awareness, movement, sensation, behavior, or autonomic function.

### **Selective Deficiency Of IgA**

Selective deficiency of IgA examines selective deficiency of iga; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Selective Mutism - Resources**

Selective mutism - resources examines selective mutism - resources; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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## **Selenium In Diet**

Selenium in diet addresses care related to selenium in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Self Catheterization - Female**

Intermittent insertion and removal of a catheter through the female urethra to empty the bladder when normal urination is inadequate, reducing retention and protecting kidney function.

## **Self Catheterization - Male**

Intermittent insertion and removal of a catheter through the male urethra to drain the bladder when neurologic, obstructive, or other conditions prevent adequate emptying.

## **Self-Testing For COVID-19**

Self-testing for COVID-19 involves toxic or environmental exposure to self-testing for covid-19; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Sensitivity Analysis**

Sensitivity analysis examines sensitivity analysis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Sensorimotor Polyneuropathy**

Sensorimotor polyneuropathy affects multiple peripheral nerves and causes combinations of numbness, pain, weakness, impaired reflexes, and distal muscle wasting.

## **Sensorineural Deafness**

Sensorineural deafness is hearing loss from dysfunction of the inner ear, auditory nerve, or central pathways rather than blockage of sound conduction.

## **Separation Anxiety In Children**

Developmentally excessive distress when separated from an attachment figure, with worry, refusal, physical symptoms, nightmares, or school avoidance that

impairs daily life.

## **Septoplasty - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to septoplasty - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Serology For Brucellosis**

Serology for brucellosis examines serology for brucellosis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Serosanguineous**

Serosanguineous describes thin wound or body fluid containing both clear serum and a small amount of blood, often appearing pink or pale red.

## **Serotonin Blood Test**

Serotonin blood test examines serotonin blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Sertoli-Leydig Cell Tumor**

Sertoli-Leydig cell tumor refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## **Serum Free Hemoglobin Test**

Serum free hemoglobin test examines serum free hemoglobin test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Serum Herpes Simplex Antibodies**

Serum herpes simplex antibodies is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

## **Serum Iron Test**

Serum iron test examines serum iron test; interpre-

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tation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Serum Phenylalanine Screening**

Serum phenylalanine screening examines serum phenylalanine screening; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Serum Progesterone**

Serum progesterone is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

### **Severe COVID-19 - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to severe covid-19 - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Sex-Linked Dominant**

Sex-linked dominant inheritance occurs when a disease-causing variant on a sex chromosome can produce the trait with one altered copy, with transmission patterns differing by sex.

### **Sex-Linked Recessive**

Sex-linked recessive inheritance usually involves a variant on the X chromosome, affecting males more often while females may be carriers or variably affected.

### **Sexual Abuse In Children - What To Know**

Child sexual abuse is any sexual activity, exploitation, or exposure imposed on a child; safety, supportive medical assessment, and safeguarding response are urgent priorities.

### **Sexual Assault - Prevention**

Sexual assault - prevention addresses care related to sexual assault - prevention, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Sexual Violence**

Sexual violence is any sexual act, attempt, contact, or coercion without freely given consent and can cause physical injury, infection, pregnancy, trauma, and long-term health effects.

### **Shampoo - Swallowing**

A medical term referring to shampoo - swallowing. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Shaving Cream Poisoning**

Shaving cream poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to shaving cream poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Shellac Poisoning**

Shellac poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to shellac poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Shin Splints - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shin splints - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Shingles - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shingles - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Short Bones**

Short bones concerns short bones, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Short Philtrum**

A short philtrum is reduced distance between the nose and upper lip and may be an isolated feature or part of a genetic, developmental, or prenatal-exposure syndrome.

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## Shoulder Arthroscopy

A medical term referring to shoulder arthroscopy. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Shoulder CT Scan

Shoulder CT scan examines shoulder ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Shoulder MRI Scan

Shoulder MRI scan examines shoulder mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Shoulder Replacement

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shoulder replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Shoulder Replacement - Discharge

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shoulder replacement - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Shoulder Separation - Aftercare

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shoulder separation - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Shoulder Surgery - Discharge

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to shoulder surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Sialogram

Sialogram examines sialogram; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## Sickle Cell Anemia - Resources

Sickle cell anemia - resources addresses care related to sickle cell anemia - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Sickle Cell Test

Sickle cell test examines sickle cell test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## SIDS - Resources

SIDS - resources addresses care related to sids - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## Signs Of An Asthma Attack

An asthma attack may cause worsening wheeze, cough, chest tightness, breathlessness, rapid breathing, difficulty speaking, or reduced peak flow; severe symptoms need emergency care.

## Silent Thyroiditis

Silent thyroiditis is painless autoimmune inflammation of the thyroid that may briefly release excess hormone before causing temporary hypothyroidism and eventual recovery.

## Silver-Russell Syndrome

A clinical condition involving silver-Russell Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Simple Goiter

A simple goiter is noncancerous enlargement of the thyroid without obvious thyroid-hormone excess or deficiency, caused by iodine imbalance, stimulation, or other factors.

## Simple Prostatectomy

Simple prostatectomy examines simple prostatectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.



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### **Simple Pulmonary Eosinophilia**

A biomedical term referring to simple pulmonary eosinophilia; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Simple, Heart-Smart Substitutions**

Simple, heart-smart substitutions concerns simple, heart-smart substitutions, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Single Palmar Crease**

A single transverse palmar crease is one crease crossing the palm instead of the usual two; it can be a normal variant or a feature of genetic syndromes.

### **Sinus CT Scan**

Sinus CT scan examines sinus ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sinus MRI Scan**

Sinus MRI scan examines sinus mri scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sinus X-Ray**

Sinus x-ray examines sinus x-ray; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sinusitis In Adults - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to sinusitis in adults - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Sitz Bath**

A medical term referring to sitz bath. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Skeletal Limb Abnormalities**

Skeletal limb abnormalities are differences in the formation, length, alignment, or structure of an arm

or leg caused by genetic, developmental, vascular, injury, or other factors.

### **Skier's Thumb - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to skier's thumb - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Skilled Nursing Facilities After Joint Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to skilled nursing facilities after joint replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Skilled Nursing Or Rehabilitation Facilities**

Skilled nursing or rehabilitation facilities addresses care related to skilled nursing or rehabilitation facilities, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Skin - Clammy**

Skin - clammy concerns skin - clammy, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Skin Abscess**

Skin abscess concerns skin abscess, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Skin And Hair Changes During Pregnancy**

Pregnancy can alter pigmentation, hair growth or shedding, acne, stretch marks, and vascular features through hormonal and circulatory changes; concerning lesions need assessment.

### **Skin Blushing/Flushing**

Skin blushing/flushing concerns skin blushing/flushing, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

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## **Skin Care And Incontinence**

Skin care and incontinence addresses care related to skin care and incontinence, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Skin Findings In Newborns**

Skin findings in newborns concerns skin findings in newborns, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Skin Flaps And Grafts - Self-Care**

Care after reconstructive skin surgery that protects the flap or graft, keeps dressings clean, avoids pressure and smoking, monitors color and temperature, and reports infection or loss of blood supply.

## **Skin Lesion Aspiration**

Skin lesion aspiration concerns skin lesion aspiration, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Skin Lesion Biopsy**

Skin lesion biopsy examines skin lesion biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Skin Lesion KOH Exam**

Skin lesion KOH exam examines skin lesion koh exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Skin Lesion Of Blastomycosis**

A blastomycosis skin lesion results from dissemination of Blastomyces fungal infection and may appear as verrucous or ulcerated lesions with raised borders.

## **Skin Lesion Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to skin lesion removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Skin Lesion Removal - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to skin lesion removal - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Skin Lumps**

Skin lumps are localized bumps or masses caused by cysts, lipomas, inflamed follicles, infections, benign tumors, or less commonly cancer; persistence or change warrants assessment.

## **Skin Nodules**

Skin nodules concerns skin nodules, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Skin Or Nail Culture**

Skin or nail culture examines skin or nail culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Skin Sagging Treatment - Underarms**

Skin sagging treatment - underarms concerns skin sagging treatment - underarms, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Skin Self-Exam**

Skin self-exam examines skin self-exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Skull X-Ray**

Skull x-ray examines skull x-ray; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Sleep And Your Health**

Sleep and your health addresses care related to sleep and your health, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

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## **Sleep Disorders**

Conditions affecting quality, timing, and amount of sleep; includes insomnia, sleep apnea, narcolepsy, restless legs syndrome, and parasomnias.

## **Sleep Disorders In Older Adults**

Sleep disorders in older adults addresses care related to sleep disorders in older adults, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Sleepwalking And Children**

Sleepwalking and children addresses care related to sleepwalking and children, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Slipping Rib Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving slipping Rib Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## **Slit-Lamp Exam**

Slit-lamp exam examines slit-lamp exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Slow Heart Rate - Bradycardia**

Slow heart rate - bradycardia concerns slow heart rate - bradycardia, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Small Bowel Resection**

Small bowel resection examines small bowel resection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Small Bowel Resection - Discharge**

Small bowel resection - discharge examines small bowel resection - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Small Bowel Tissue Smear/Biopsy**

Small bowel tissue smear/biopsy examines small bowel tissue smear/biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Small For Gestational Age (SGA)**

Birth weight or size below the expected range for gestational age, caused by constitutional small size, placental insufficiency, infection, genetic disease, or maternal factors.

## **Small Intestinal Ischemia And Infarction**

Small intestinal ischemia and infarction examines small intestinal ischemia and infarction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Small Intestine Aspirate And Culture**

Small intestine aspirate and culture examines small intestine aspirate and culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Smallpox/Monkeypox Vaccine (JYNNEOS) - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to smallpox/monkeypox vaccine (jynneos) - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Smashed Fingers**

A smashed finger may injure skin, nail, bone, tendon, or nerve; deformity, severe pain, numbness, impaired movement, or blood under the nail may require urgent evaluation.

## **Smear Of Duodenal Fluid Aspirate**

Smear of duodenal fluid aspirate examines smear of duodenal fluid aspirate; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Smell - Impaired**

Reduced or absent ability to detect odors, called

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hyposmia or anosmia, caused by nasal obstruction, viral injury, head trauma, neurodegeneration, medications, or other disease.

### **Smoking And Asthma**

Smoking irritates and inflames airways, worsens asthma control, increases attacks, and reduces treatment response; stopping smoking and avoiding secondhand smoke improve outcomes.

### **Smoking And COPD**

Smoking is the major preventable cause of COPD and accelerates lung-function loss; quitting reduces progression and exacerbations even after COPD is established.

### **Smoking And Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to smoking and surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Smoking Cessation Medications**

Medicines that reduce nicotine withdrawal and cravings, including nicotine replacement, bupropion, and varenicline, used with behavioral support and individualized for health risks and preferences.

### **Snacking When You Have Diabetes**

Planning snacks for diabetes by considering hunger, glucose pattern, activity, carbohydrate amount, medicine timing, and hypoglycemia risk rather than relying on unrestricted grazing.

### **Snacks And Sweetened Drinks - Children**

Frequent sugary snacks and drinks increase children's risk of tooth decay and excess weight; water, nutritious foods, portions, and regular meals are healthier defaults.

### **Snacks For Adults**

Healthy adult snacks emphasize nutrient-dense foods such as fruit, vegetables, legumes, nuts, yogurt, or whole grains while limiting excess sugar, salt, and highly processed calories.

### **Snake Bites**

Snake bites involves toxic or environmental exposure to snake bites; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Snoring - Adults**

Noisy breathing during sleep caused by vibration of relaxed tissues in the nose, mouth, or throat; loud habitual snoring with witnessed pauses or daytime sleepiness may indicate obstructive sleep apnea.

### **Sodium Bisulfate Poisoning**

Sodium bisulfate poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sodium bisulfate poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Sodium Blood Test**

Sodium blood test examines sodium blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sodium Carbonate Poisoning**

Sodium carbonate poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sodium carbonate poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Sodium Hydroxide Poisoning**

Sodium hydroxide poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sodium hydroxide poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Sodium Hypochlorite Poisoning**

Sodium hypochlorite poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sodium hypochlorite poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Sodium In Diet**

Sodium in diet addresses care related to sodium in diet, including practical measures, warning signs,

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follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Sodium Urine Test**

Sodium urine test examines sodium urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Solder Poisoning**

Solder poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to solder poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Solitary Fibrous Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving solitary Fibrous Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Soluble Vs. Insoluble Fiber**

Soluble fiber dissolves or gels in water and can affect glucose, cholesterol, and stool consistency, while insoluble fiber adds bulk and supports bowel movement; foods often contain both.

### **Soy**

Soy is a legume providing protein and isoflavones; it is nutritious for many people but can cause allergy and may interact with some medicines or thyroid treatment timing.

### **Spasmodic Dysphonia**

Spasmodic dysphonia is a focal laryngeal dystonia causing involuntary voice-box spasms and strained, breathy, or interrupted speech.

### **Spasmus Nutans**

An uncommon early-childhood syndrome of rapid shimmering eye movements, head nodding, and torticollis that usually resolves but requires evaluation to exclude neurologic or ocular disease.

### **Speech Disorders - Children**

A clinical finding or condition involving speech Disorders - Children; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Speech Impairment In Adults**

Difficulty producing or understanding speech caused by aphasia, dysarthria, apraxia, hearing loss, neurologic disease, structural problems, or cognitive disorder; sudden onset requires stroke assessment.

### **Spina Bifida - Resources**

Spina bifida - resources addresses care related to spina bifida - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Spinal And Epidural Anesthesia**

Spinal and epidural anesthesia deliver local anesthetic near spinal nerves to numb the lower body; spinal is a single injection, while epidural uses a catheter for adjustable dosing.

### **Spinal Cord Abscess**

A spinal cord or epidural abscess is a collection of infection near the spinal cord that can compress neural tissue and cause pain, fever, weakness, paralysis, or bladder problems.

### **Spinal Cord Stimulation**

An implanted treatment that delivers electrical impulses to the epidural space to alter pain signaling, used for selected chronic neuropathic or ischemic pain after careful assessment.

### **Spinal Cord Trauma**

Spinal cord trauma is injury to the cord from force such as fracture, dislocation, or penetrating damage, potentially causing weakness, sensory loss, autonomic dysfunction, or paralysis.

### **Spinal Injury**

A clinical condition involving spinal Injury; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Spinal Injury - Resources**

Spinal injury - resources addresses care related to spinal injury - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to

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discuss with a clinician.

### **Spinal Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving spinal Tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Spine Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to spine surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Spitting Up - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to spitting up - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Spleen Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to spleen removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Spleen Removal - Child - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to spleen removal - child - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Splinter Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to splinter removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Spores**

A medical term referring to spores. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sports Cream Overdose**

Sports cream overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to sports cream overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement

determine urgency and treatment.

### **Sports Physical**

Sports physical addresses care related to sports physical, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Sputum Culture**

Sputum culture examines sputum culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sputum Direct Fluorescent Antibody (DFA) Test**

Sputum direct fluorescent antibody (DFA) test examines sputum direct fluorescent antibody (dfa) test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sputum Fungal Smear**

Sputum fungal smear examines sputum fungal smear; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sputum Gram Stain**

Sputum Gram stain examines sputum gram stain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sputum Stain For Mycobacteria**

Sputum stain for mycobacteria examines sputum stain for mycobacteria; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Squamous Cell Skin Cancer**

Squamous cell skin cancer is a malignant keratinocyte tumor often arising on sun-exposed skin and capable of local invasion or metastasis, especially when high risk.



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### **Standard Eye Exam**

Standard eye exam examines standard eye exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Staph Infections - Self-Care At Home**

Staph infections - self-care at home examines staph infections - self-care at home; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Staph Infections In The Hospital**

Staph infections in the hospital examines staph infections in the hospital; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Staphylococcal Meningitis**

Staphylococcal meningitis is infection and inflammation of the meninges caused by Staphylococcus bacteria, often after surgery, trauma, bloodstream infection, or an invasive device.

### **Starch Poisoning**

Starch poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to starch poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Stasis Dermatitis And Ulcers**

Stasis dermatitis and ulcers result from chronic venous hypertension in the lower legs, causing swelling, brown skin change, inflammation, itching, and slow-healing wounds.

### **Stay Active And Exercise When You Have Arthritis**

Stay active and exercise when you have arthritis examines stay active and exercise when you have arthritis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stay Away From Asthma Triggers**

Avoiding asthma triggers such as smoke, allergens, infections, fumes, and cold air can reduce symptoms and attacks, alongside prescribed controller and reliever treatment.

### **Staying Safe At Home**

Staying safe at home addresses care related to staying safe at home, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Steam Iron Cleaner Poisoning**

Steam iron cleaner poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to steam iron cleaner poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Steps To Take Before You Get Pregnant**

Preconception care includes reviewing health conditions and medicines, folic acid, vaccinations, dental and genetic considerations, substance avoidance, and planning prenatal care.

### **Stereotactic Radiosurgery - CyberKnife**

Stereotactic radiosurgery - CyberKnife examines stereotactic radiosurgery - cyberknife; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stereotactic Radiosurgery - Discharge**

Stereotactic radiosurgery - discharge examines stereotactic radiosurgery - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stereotactic Radiosurgery - Gamma Knife**

Stereotactic radiosurgery - Gamma Knife examines stereotactic radiosurgery - gamma knife; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stereotypic Movement Disorder**

A clinical condition involving stereotypic Movement

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Disorder; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Sterile Technique**

A medical term referring to sterile technique. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sterilization Surgery - Making A Decision**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to sterilization surgery - making a decision; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Sternal Exploration Or Closure**

Surgical reopening or repair of the breastbone after median sternotomy, performed to treat infection, bleeding, instability, dehiscence, or other postoperative chest complications.

### **Steroid Injections - Tendon, Bursa, Joint**

Steroid injections - tendon, bursa, joint examines steroid injections - tendon, bursa, joint; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stimulus**

A stimulus is a physical, chemical, sensory, or social change that evokes a response from a cell, tissue, organism, or person.

### **Stingray**

Stingray involves toxic or environmental exposure to stingray; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Stoddard Solvent Poisoning**

Stoddard solvent poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to stoddard solvent poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Stonefish Sting**

Stonefish sting involves toxic or environmental exposure to stonefish sting; dose, route, timing, symp-

toms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Stool C Difficile Toxin**

Stool C difficile toxin is a diagnostic or laboratory investigation; interpretation depends on the specimen, method, reference interval, timing, and clinical question.

### **Stool Gram Stain**

Stool Gram stain examines stool gram stain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stool Guaiac Test**

Stool guaiac test examines stool guaiac test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stool Ova And Parasites Exam**

Stool ova and parasites exam examines stool ova and parasites exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stools – Floating**

Feces that remain on the water surface, often from trapped gas or diet but sometimes from excess fat in malabsorption; persistent greasy, pale, foul-smelling stool needs evaluation.

### **Stools - Foul Smelling**

Strongly odorous feces that may result from diet, infection, bleeding, malabsorption, altered gut bacteria, or rapid transit; persistent change with weight loss or diarrhea warrants review.

### **Stools - Pale Or Clay-Colored**

Light-colored stool caused by reduced bile pigment reaching the intestine, potentially indicating bile-duct obstruction, gallbladder disease, liver disease, or certain transient conditions.

### **Stop Smoking Support Programs**

Stop smoking support programs addresses care re-

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lated to stop smoking support programs, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Storing Your Medicines**

Medicines should be stored in their labeled containers at the specified temperature, protected from moisture and children, and checked for expiry or disposal instructions.

### **Stork Bite**

A stork bite is a common harmless pink birthmark, usually a nevus simplex on the forehead, eyelids, nose, or neck, that often fades during childhood.

### **Strains**

A strain is overstretching or tearing of a muscle or tendon, causing pain, tenderness, swelling, weakness, or reduced function after force or overuse.

### **Strategies For Getting Through Labor**

A medical term referring to strategies for getting through labor. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Streptococcal Screen**

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### **Stress And Your Health**

Stress and your health addresses care related to stress and your health, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Stress And Your Heart**

Stress and your heart addresses care related to stress and your heart, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Stress In Childhood**

Stress in childhood addresses care related to stress

in childhood, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Stretch Marks**

Linear bands of atrophic skin, also called striae, caused by stretching and hormonal or corticosteroid effects; they commonly occur during pregnancy, growth, weight change, or steroid exposure.

### **String Test For Intestinal Parasites**

String test for intestinal parasites examines string test for intestinal parasites; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stroke - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to stroke - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Stroke Risk Factors**

Stroke risk factors examines stroke risk factors; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Stuffy Or Runny Nose – Adult**

A stuffy or runny nose in an adult commonly results from viral infection, allergy, irritants, or sinus disease; persistent, severe, bloody, or one-sided symptoms need review.

### **Stuffy Or Runny Nose - Children**

A stuffy or runny nose in a child is usually caused by a viral infection or allergy; breathing difficulty, dehydration, prolonged fever, or symptoms in an infant need prompt assessment.

### **Subacute Combined Degeneration**

Subacute combined degeneration concerns subacute combined degeneration, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

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### **Subareolar Abscess**

A pus-filled infection beneath the areola, often associated with periductal inflammation and smoking, causing a painful lump, redness, drainage, or recurrent fistula.

### **Subconjunctival Hemorrhage**

Subconjunctival hemorrhage examines subconjunctival hemorrhage; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Subcutaneous (SQ) Injections**

Subcutaneous (SQ) injections examines subcutaneous (sq) injections; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Subcutaneous Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to subcutaneous implantable cardioverter-defibrillator; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Subdural Effusion**

Accumulation of usually clear fluid in the subdural space, often after trauma, surgery, infection, or cerebrospinal-fluid disturbance and sometimes causing headache or pressure effects.

### **Substance Use - Amphetamines**

Amphetamine use can cause dependence, insomnia, anxiety, psychosis, high blood pressure, arrhythmias, overheating, and overdose; urgent symptoms require emergency care.

### **Substance Use - Cocaine**

A medical term referring to substance use - cocaine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Substance Use - Inhalants**

Inhalant misuse involves breathing fumes or gases

from household or industrial products and can cause sudden cardiac arrest, brain injury, organ damage, dependence, or death.

### **Substance Use - LSD**

LSD is a potent hallucinogen that alters perception, mood, and thought and can cause panic, accidents, persistent perceptual symptoms, or psychosis in susceptible people.

### **Substance Use - Marijuana**

Marijuana or cannabis can impair attention, memory, coordination, and driving and may cause dependence, anxiety, psychosis, or respiratory harm when smoked.

### **Substance Use - Phencyclidine (PCP)**

Phencyclidine is a dissociative drug that can cause agitation, hallucinations, loss of coordination, high blood pressure, seizures, dangerous behavior, or coma.

### **Substance Use - Prescription Drugs**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called substance use - prescription drugs. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Substance Use Recovery And Diet**

Substance use recovery and diet addresses care related to substance use recovery and diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Sugar-Water Hemolysis Test**

Sugar-water hemolysis test examines sugar-water hemolysis test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Suicide And Suicidal Behavior**

Thoughts, plans, attempts, or acts intended to cause one's own death; any current intent, plan, access to means, or inability to stay safe requires immediate emergency support.

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## **Sulfuric Acid Poisoning**

Sulfuric acid poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to sulfuric acid poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Sulindac Overdose**

Sulindac overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to sulindac overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **Sun Protection**

Sun protection examines sun protection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Supernumerary Nipples**

Supernumerary nipples are extra nipples along the embryonic milk line, usually harmless but occasionally associated with underlying breast or urinary-tract developmental anomalies.

## **Supporting Your Child With Weight Loss**

Supporting your child with weight loss addresses care related to supporting your child with weight loss, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Supranuclear Ophthalmoplegia**

Supranuclear ophthalmoplegia concerns supranuclear ophthalmoplegia, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

## **Suprapubic Catheter Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to suprapubic catheter care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Surgery For Pancreatic Cancer**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to surgery for pancreatic cancer; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on

the specific intervention and patient.

## **Surgery For Pancreatic Cancer - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to surgery for pancreatic cancer - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Surgery For Pilonidal Cyst**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to surgery for pilonidal cyst; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Surgical Excision**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to surgical excision; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## **Surgical Wound Care - Closed**

Surgical wound care - closed addresses care related to surgical wound care - closed, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Surgical Wound Care - Open**

Surgical wound care - open addresses care related to surgical wound care - open, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

## **Surgical Wound Infection - Treatment**

Surgical wound infection - treatment examines surgical wound infection - treatment; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Sutures - Ridged**

Ridged cranial sutures are raised skull seams in an infant and may reflect normal molding or premature suture fusion, which requires assessment for craniosynostosis.

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### **Sutures - Separated**

Separated cranial sutures in an infant can reflect normal growth or increased intracranial pressure, hydrocephalus, prematurity, or other illness and require clinical assessment.

### **SVC Obstruction**

SVC obstruction examines svc obstruction; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Swallowing Chalk**

A medical term referring to swallowing chalk. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Swallowing Difficulty**

A medical term referring to swallowing difficulty. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Swallowing Problems**

A medical term referring to swallowing problems. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Swallowing Soap**

A medical term referring to swallowing soap. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Swallowing Sunscreen**

Ingestion of sunscreen, usually causing mild gastrointestinal upset but potentially causing choking or aspiration depending on amount and product; breathing difficulty or persistent vomiting requires urgent help.

### **Swan-Ganz - Right Heart Catheterization**

Insertion of a pulmonary-artery catheter through the right heart to measure central venous, pulmonary-artery, and wedge pressures and cardiac output in selected critically ill patients.

### **Sweat Electrolytes Test**

Sweat electrolytes test examines sweat electrolytes test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Sweetened Beverages**

Sweetened beverages contain added sugars and can increase calorie intake, dental caries, obesity, and diabetes risk when consumed frequently.

### **Sweeteners - Sugar Substitutes**

Sugar substitutes provide sweetness with little or no sugar; types differ in energy, digestion, after-taste, and effects on glucose and gastrointestinal symptoms.

### **Sweeteners - Sugars**

Sugars are simple carbohydrates that provide energy but can raise blood glucose and contribute to dental decay or excess calories when consumed in excess.

### **Swimmer's Ear**

Swimmer's ear concerns swimmer's ear, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ear Infection, Outer Ear Outer Ear Infection

### **Swimming Pool Cleaner Poisoning**

Swimming pool cleaner poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to swimming pool cleaner poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Swimming Pool Granuloma**

Swimming-pool granuloma is a skin infection caused by *Mycobacterium marinum* after exposure to contaminated water, producing persistent nodules along lymphatic channels.

### **Swollen Lymph Nodes**

Swollen lymph nodes are enlarged immune glands, commonly from infection but sometimes from in-



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flammation, medication, or cancer; persistent, hard, or generalized nodes need evaluation.

**Synonyms:**

Lymph Nodes, Swollen Lymph Swollen Glands (Swollen Lymph Nodes) Lymph Swollen Nodes (Swollen Lymph Nodes)

**Sydenham Chorea**

A delayed neurologic complication of group A streptococcal infection causing involuntary jerky movements, hypotonia, emotional lability, and coordination problems, usually in children.

**Syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion**

A clinical condition involving syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

**Synovial Biopsy**

Synovial biopsy examines synovial biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

**Syphilitic Aseptic Meningitis**

Syphilitic aseptic meningitis is inflammation of the meninges caused by *Treponema pallidum*, producing headache, neck stiffness, cranial-nerve symptoms, or other neurologic findings.

**Sacroiliac Joint Dysfunction (Sacroiliac Joint Pain)**

Alternate index label for Sacroiliac Joint Pain.

**Sacroiliac Joint Pain**

Sacroiliac-joint pain arises near the junction of the lower spine and pelvis and may follow injury, pregnancy, arthritis, leg-length or gait changes, or inflammation. Pain can radiate to the buttock or thigh; examination distinguishes it from hip or spine disease.

**Synonyms:**

Sacroiliac Joint Dysfunction (Sacroiliac Joint Pain)

**SAD (Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD))**

Alternate index label for Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD).

**Salmonella Contagious (Is Salmonella Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Salmonella Contagious.

**Salmonella Food Poisoning (Salmonellosis)**

Alternate index label for Salmonellosis.

**Sarcoptic Mange (Scabies)**

Alternate index label for Scabies.

**Scabies Contagious (Is Scabies Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Scabies Contagious.

**Scalp And Body (Ringworm)**

Alternate index label for Ringworm.

**Scar Excessive (Keloid)**

Alternate index label for Keloid.

**Scarlatina (Scarlet Fever (Scarlatina))**

Alternate index label for Scarlet Fever (Scarlatina).

**Scarlet Fever (Scarlatina)**

Alternate index label for Scarletina.

**Scarlet Fever Contagious (Is Scarlet Fever Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Scarlet Fever Contagious.

**Scars**

A scar is fibrous tissue formed during healing after injury, surgery, inflammation, or burns. Scars may be flat, depressed, raised, or contractured and can itch, hurt, restrict movement, or affect appearance; treatment depends on maturity and type.

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### **School Sores (Impetigo)**

Alternate index label for Impetigo.

### **Sciatic Neuritis (Sciatica)**

Alternate index label for Sciatica.

### **Sciatica: Causes, Treatment, And Symptoms**

Sciatica is radiating pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness along the sciatic-nerve distribution, commonly from lumbar disc herniation or spinal narrowing. Most cases improve with conservative care, but saddle numbness, bowel or bladder dysfunction, or progressive weakness is urgent.

### **Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD)**

Alternate index label for SAD.

### **Seasonal Allergies (Hay Fever)**

Alternate index label for Hay Fever.

### **Seborrhea**

Seborrhea is excessive or altered oil production that contributes to greasy scale and inflammation, commonly in seborrheic dermatitis of the scalp, face, or chest. Gentle cleansing, medicated shampoos, and topical anti-inflammatory or antifungal treatment may help.

### **SEID (Chronic Fatigue Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Chronic Fatigue Syndrome.

### **Seizure Febrile (Febrile Seizures)**

Alternate index label for Febrile Seizures.

### **Seizure Fever Induced (Febrile Seizures)**

Alternate index label for Febrile Seizures.

### **Seizures Symptoms And Types**

Seizures are episodes of abnormal electrical brain activity that may cause staring, altered awareness, unusual sensations, stiffening, rhythmic movements, loss of tone, or post-event confusion. First seizure, prolonged seizure, injury, pregnancy, or repeated events requires urgent care.

### **Self Gratification Sexual (Masturbation)**

Alternate index label for Masturbation.

### **Self-Diagnosing Body Dysmorphic Disorder (BDD)**

Alternate index label for BDD.

### **Semaglutide**

Semaglutide is a glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonist used for selected patients with type 2 diabetes or chronic weight management. It slows gastric emptying and reduces appetite and glucose levels; nausea, gallbladder disease, pancreatitis risk, and contraindications require review.

### **Semen Blood (Blood In Semen)**

Alternate index label for Blood In Semen.

### **Sensitivity, Gluten (Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance))**

Alternate index label for Nonceliac Gluten Sensitivity (Intolerance).

### **Sentinel Lymph Node Biopsy For Melanoma**

Sentinel lymph-node biopsy identifies and removes the first draining lymph node or nodes from a melanoma site to detect microscopic spread. The result helps stage disease and guide further treatment; it does not remove all regional nodes routinely.

### **Separation Anxiety**

Separation anxiety is developmentally excessive fear or distress when apart from an attachment figure, causing avoidance, physical complaints, sleep problems, or impairment. Treatment may include gradual exposure, family-based support, cognitive behavioral therapy, and selected medication.

#### **Synonyms:**

Children Separation Anxiety (Separation Anxiety)

### **SepsContagious (Is Sepsis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Sepsis Contagious.

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## **Septicemia (Sepsis)**

Alternate index label for Sepsis.

## **Septum Deviated (Deviated Septum)**

Alternate index label for Deviated Septum.

## **Serious Diseases And Health Problems (Symptoms Of Serious Diseases And Health Problems)**

Alternate index label for Symptoms of Serious Diseases and Health Problems.

## **Serous Cyst Adenomas Pancreas (Pancreatic Cysts)**

Alternate index label for Pancreatic Cysts.

## **Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS))**

Alternate index label for Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS).

## **Severe Condition (Sever Condition)**

Alternate index label for Sever Condition.

## **Sexual (Sex) Problems In Men**

Alternate index label for Sex) Problems in Me.

## **Sexual Addiction**

Compulsive sexual behavior involves persistent difficulty controlling sexual thoughts or behaviors despite distress or harm. It is not simply a high sex drive; assessment considers mood disorders, trauma, substance use, relationships, consent, and evidence-based behavioral treatment.

### **Synonyms:**

Addiction Sexual (Sexual Addiction)

## **Sexual Health Overview**

Sexual health includes physical, emotional, mental, and social well-being in relation to sexuality and relationships. It includes consent, contraception, sexually transmitted infection prevention and testing, fertility, sexual function, safety, and respectful communication.

## **Sexually Transmitted Disease (STD) Treatments**

Alternate index label for STD) Treatment.

## **Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs In Women)**

Alternate index label for STDs In Women.

## **Sexually Transmitted Diseases And Pregnancy (STDs)**

Alternate index label for STDs.

## **Shaken Baby Syndrome (Abusive Head Trauma)**

Alternate index label for Abusive Head Trauma.

## **Sharp Pains In Your Stomach During Pregnancy**

Sharp abdominal pain in pregnancy may result from ligament stretching, gas, constipation, uterine contractions, urinary disease, ectopic pregnancy, placental complications, or other causes. Severe or persistent pain, bleeding, fever, faintness, vomiting, or reduced fetal movement needs urgent obstetric assessment.

## **Shingles (Herpes Zoster)**

Alternate index label for Herpes Zoster.

## **Shingles And Pregnancy**

Shingles is reactivation of varicella-zoster virus and usually causes a painful one-sided blistering rash. It is not the same as primary chickenpox exposure, but pregnancy requires prompt clinical advice about treatment, pain, and contact with people at risk.

## **Shoulder Bursitis**

Shoulder bursitis is inflammation of a fluid-filled sac around the shoulder, often associated with rotator-cuff disease or repetitive overhead activity. Pain with elevation and lying on the affected side is common; activity modification, therapy, medicines, injection, or treatment of the underlying cause may help.

### **Synonyms:**

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Bursitis Shoulder (Shoulder Bursitis)

### **Shulmans Syndrome (Eosinophilic Fasciitis)**

Alternate index label for Eosinophilic Fasciitis.

### **Sick Building Syndrome**

Sick building syndrome describes nonspecific symptoms such as headache, fatigue, eye or throat irritation, cough, dizziness, or nausea associated with time in a building and improving away from it. Ventilation, humidity, pollutants, mold, and other environmental factors should be assessed.

### **Sickle Cell**

Sickle-cell disease is an inherited hemoglobin disorder causing red cells to become rigid and sickle-shaped, leading to anemia, painful vaso-occlusive episodes, infection risk, stroke, acute chest syndrome, and organ damage. Comprehensive preventive and disease-modifying care is needed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Sickle Cell Anemia (Sickle Cell)

### **Sickle Cell Anemia (Sickle Cell)**

Alternate index label for Sickle Cell.

### **Sickness Motion (Motion Sickness (Sea Sickness, Car Sickness))**

Alternate index label for Motion Sickness (Sea Sickness, Car Sickness).

### **Silent Sinus Syndrome**

Silent sinus syndrome is painless inward collapse of the maxillary sinus and floor of the orbit, often causing facial asymmetry, enophthalmos, or a sunken eye. Imaging confirms the diagnosis, and endoscopic treatment restores sinus ventilation when indicated.

### **Silk Road Disease (Behcet's Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Behcet's Syndrome.

### **Sinus Headache**

Pain attributed to a sinus headache is often migraine, but sinus inflammation can cause facial pressure,

congestion, reduced smell, and pain that worsens with bending. Fever, purulent discharge, persistent symptoms, or eye or neurologic signs guide evaluation.

### **Sixth Disease (Roseola)**

Alternate index label for Roseola.

### **Skin Anatomy Picture Definition Function**

Skin consists of epidermis, dermis, and subcutaneous tissue with appendages such as hair, nails, glands, nerves, vessels, and immune cells. It forms a barrier, regulates temperature, senses the environment, prevents fluid loss, and participates in immunity and vitamin D production.

### **Skin Cancer Overview**

Skin cancer includes basal-cell carcinoma, squamous-cell carcinoma, melanoma, and less common tumors. Ultraviolet exposure, immune suppression, genetic susceptibility, and certain lesions increase risk; a changing, bleeding, nonhealing, or unusual lesion needs examination.

#### **Synonyms:**

Melanoma (Skin Cancer Overview)

### **Skin Rashes Contagious (Are Skin Rashes Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Are Skin Rashes Contagious.

### **Skin Tag**

A skin tag is a benign soft growth of connective tissue, commonly in body folds and associated with friction, age, pregnancy, obesity, or insulin resistance. Removal may be performed for irritation or appearance, but a changing or atypical lesion should be diagnosed first.

#### **Synonyms:**

Acrochordon (Skin Tag)

### **SLE (Systemic Lupus)**

Alternate index label for Systemic Lupus.

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## **Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens**

Children and teens need age-appropriate sleep, and disorders may involve insomnia, circadian delay, sleep apnea, parasomnias, restless legs, or insufficient opportunity. Snoring, pauses in breathing, unusual daytime sleepiness, mood change, or poor school performance warrants evaluation.

### **Synonyms:**

Children Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Disorders Sleep In Children (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Disorders Sleep In Teenagers (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Infants Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Toddlers Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Tweens Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens) Younger Children Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)

## **Sleep Disorder Periodic Limb Movement (Periodic Limb Movement Disorder)**

Alternate index label for Periodic Limb Movement Disorder.

## **Sleep Related Breathing Disorders**

Sleep-related breathing disorders cause abnormal ventilation or oxygenation during sleep, including obstructive and central sleep apnea and sleep-related hypoventilation. Snoring, witnessed pauses, gasping, morning headache, or daytime sleepiness may prompt sleep testing and treatment.

### **Synonyms:**

Breathing Disorders Sleep Related (Sleep Related Breathing Disorders)

## **Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth (SIBO)**

Alternate index label for SIBO.

## **Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth (Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth (SIBO))**

Alternate index label for Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth (SIBO).

## **Smoke Secondhand (Secondhand Smoke)**

Alternate index label for Secondhand Smoke.

## **Smokeless Tobacco**

Smokeless tobacco delivers nicotine and causes dependence, oral lesions, gum recession, tooth loss, cardiovascular risk, and cancers of the mouth, throat, and pancreas. Quitting reduces harm, and counseling plus approved medicines improve cessation success.

### **Synonyms:**

Tobacco Chewing (Smokeless Tobacco)

## **Smokers Keratosis (Leukoplakia)**

Alternate index label for Leukoplakia.

## **Smokers Lung (Smoker's Lung: Pathology Photo Essay)**

Alternate index label for Smoker's Lung: Pathology Photo Essay.

## **Snake Bite**

Snake bites can cause puncture wounds, tissue injury, bleeding, paralysis, or venom-related effects on clotting, nerves, muscles, kidneys, or the heart. Call emergency services, keep the person still, and do not cut, suck, ice, or tourniquet the wound.

### **Synonyms:**

Bite Snake (Snake Bite)

## **Snoring How To Stop (How To Stop Snoring)**

Alternate index label for How to Stop Snoring.

## **Social And Psychological Causes Of Alcoholism**

Alcohol-use disorder reflects interactions among genetics, brain reward pathways, stress, trauma, mental illness, social environment, and alcohol availability—not a moral failure. Treatment may include withdrawal care, counseling, peer support, and medicines that reduce drinking or relapse.

## **Sodium Low Levels In The Blood**

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### **(Hyponatremia)**

Alternate index label for Hyponatremia.

### **Solar Keratosis (Actinic Keratosis)**

Alternate index label for Actinic Keratosis.

### **Sole Sweating Excessive (Hyperhidrosis)**

Alternate index label for Hyperhidrosis.

### **Sore Throat (Pharyngitis)**

Alternate index label for Pharyngitis.

### **Sore Throat Contagious (Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Sore Throat Pharyngitis Contagious.

### **Sores Canker (Canker Sores)**

Alternate index label for Canker Sores.

### **Sores Canker Contagious (Are Canker Sores Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Are Canker Sores Contagious.

### **Spastic Colon (Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS))**

Alternate index label for Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS).

### **Spherocytos (Spherocytosis (Hereditary, HS))**

Alternate index label for Spherocytosis (Hereditary, HS).

### **Spherocytosis (Hereditary, HS)**

Alternate index label for Hereditary, HS.

### **Spider Bites (Black Widow And Brown Recluse)**

Alternate index label for Black Widow and Brown Recluse.

### **Spinal Cord Injury: Treatments And**

### **Rehabilitation**

Spinal-cord injury can cause temporary or permanent weakness, sensory loss, autonomic dysfunction, and bowel or bladder problems. Acute care protects the spine and treats complications; rehabilitation addresses mobility, skin, breathing, function, equipment, sexuality, and community participation.

### **Spleen Enlarged (Enlarged Spleen)**

Alternate index label for Enlarged Spleen.

### **Splenomegaly Gaucher (Gaucher Disease)**

Alternate index label for Gaucher Disease.

### **Sprain Neck (Whiplash)**

Alternate index label for Whiplash.

### **Sprained Ankle**

An ankle sprain is stretching or tearing of ligaments, usually after rolling the ankle inward. Pain, swelling, bruising, and instability occur; protection, relative rest, compression, elevation, and progressive rehabilitation help, while inability to bear weight may require imaging.

#### **Synonyms:**

Strains (Sprained Ankle)

### **Spring Fever (Henoch-Schonlein Purpura)**

Alternate index label for Henoch-Schonlein Purpura.

### **Spur Heel (Heel Spurs)**

Alternate index label for Heel Spurs.

### **Squamous Intraepithelial Lesion Cervical (Cervical Dysplasia)**

Alternate index label for Cervical Dysplasia.

### **Staph Infection Contagious (Is A Staph Infection Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is a Staph Infection Contagious.

### **Staphylococcus Infection (Staph**



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### **Infection)**

Alternate index label for Staph Infection.

### **STD (Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs In Women))**

Alternate index label for Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs In Women).

### **STD (Syphilis In Women Overview)**

Alternate index label for Syphilis in Women Overview.

### **Stenosis Lumbar (Lumbar Stenosis)**

Alternate index label for Lumbar Stenosis.

### **Stenosis Spinal (Lumbar Stenosis)**

Alternate index label for Lumbar Stenosis.

### **Stomach Ulcer (Peptic Ulcer)**

Alternate index label for Peptic Ulcer.

### **Strain Neck (Whiplash)**

Alternate index label for Whiplash.

### **Strains (Sprained Ankle)**

Alternate index label for Sprained Ankle.

### **Strep Throat (GAS)**

Alternate index label for GAS.

### **Streptococcal Infections**

Streptococcal bacteria can cause throat infection, scarlet fever, skin infection, pneumonia, invasive bloodstream disease, and post-infectious complications. Diagnosis and antibiotic choice depend on site and testing; severe pain, rapid spread, sepsis signs, or breathing difficulty is urgent.

### **Streptococcal Pharyngitis (Strep Throat (GAS))**

Alternate index label for Strep Throat (GAS).

### **Stress Breast Cancer (Breast Cancer And**

### **Coping With Stress)**

Alternate index label for Breast Cancer and Coping With Stress.

### **Strictures Esophagus (Schatzki Ring)**

Alternate index label for Schatzki Ring.

### **Stroke Heat (Heat Stroke)**

Alternate index label for Heat Stroke.

### **Stroke Symptoms And Treatment**

Stroke is brain injury from blocked blood flow or bleeding. Sudden facial droop, arm weakness, speech trouble, vision change, imbalance, or severe headache requires emergency activation; treatment may include clot-busting medicine, thrombectomy, bleeding control, and rehabilitation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cerebrovascular Accident (Stroke Symptoms And Treatment) CVA (Stroke Symptoms And Treatment)

### **Sty (Stye)**

Alternate index label for Stye.

### **Stye (Sty (Stye))**

Alternate index label for Sty (Stye).

### **Sun-Sensitive Drugs (Photosensitivity To Drugs)**

Alternate index label for Photosensitivity to Drugs.

### **Sun-Sensitive Drugs (Sun-Sensitive Drugs (Photosensitivity To Drugs))**

Alternate index label for Sun-Sensitive Drugs (Photosensitivity to Drugs).

### **Supraventricular Tachycardia Paroxysmal (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT))**

Alternate index label for Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT).

### **SVCS (Superior Vena Cava Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Superior Vena Cava Syn-

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drome.

### **Swimmers Ear (Otitis Externa)**

Alternate index label for Otitis Externa.

### **Swine Flu Contagious (Is Swine Flu (H1N1) Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Swine Flu (H1N1) Contagious.

### **Syndrome Asperger (Asperger Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Asperger Syndrome.

### **Syndrome Cauda Equina (Cauda Equina Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Cauda Equina Syndrome.

### **Syndrome Compartment (Compartment Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Compartment Syndrome.

### **Syndrome Cyclic Vomiting (Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome (CVS))**

Alternate index label for Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome (CVS).

### **Syndrome Loeys-Dietz (Loeys-Dietz Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Loeys-Dietz Syndrome.

### **Syndrome Pfeiffer (Pfeiffer Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Pfeiffer Syndrome.

### **Syndrome Restless Legs (Restless Leg Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Restless Leg Syndrome.

### **Syphilis In Women Overview**

Syphilis is a sexually transmitted infection caused by *Treponema pallidum* and progresses through stages that may include painless sores, rash, neurologic or cardiovascular disease, or no symptoms. Penicillin treatment cures infection and is essential in pregnancy to prevent congenital disease.

### **Synonyms:**

STD (Syphilis In Women Overview)

### **Systemic Lupus**

Systemic lupus erythematosus is an autoimmune disease that can affect skin, joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, lungs, and heart. Symptoms fluctuate, and treatment is tailored to organ involvement with sun protection, monitoring, and immunomodulatory medicines.

### **Synonyms:**

Arthritis SLE (Systemic Lupus) Lupus (Systemic Lupus) SLE (Systemic Lupus)

### **S1-S5 (Sacral Vertebrae)**

The five sacral vertebrae that fuse to form the sacrum, connect the spine to the pelvis, and provide foramina for sacral nerve roots.

### **SA Node**

The sinoatrial node is the heart's normal pacemaker, generating electrical impulses that initiate each sinus heartbeat.

### **SAA**

SAA commonly means serum amyloid A, an acute-phase protein that rises with inflammation and can contribute to secondary amyloidosis when persistently elevated.

### **Sabin, Florence R.**

Florence R. Sabin was an American physician and scientist whose research advanced understanding of lymphatic anatomy, tuberculosis, and immune-cell biology.

### **Sacral**

Sacral means relating to the sacrum, the triangular bone at the base of the spine that connects with the pelvis.

### **Sacroccocygeal**

Sacroccocygeal means relating to the sacrum and coccyx at the lower end of the vertebral column.

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### **Sacroiliac Joint Dysfunction (SI Joint Pain)**

A clinical condition involving sacroiliac Joint Dysfunction (SI Joint Pain); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Sagittal**

Sagittal means oriented from front to back and dividing the body or a structure into right and left portions.

### **Salabrasion**

A dermabrasion method using salt or an abrasive salt preparation to remove superficial skin layers; it carries risks of pain, infection, pigment change, and scarring.

### **Salient**

Salient means prominent or especially relevant; a salient clinical finding is one that stands out and may influence diagnosis or management.

### **Sanguine**

Sanguine means blood-related or blood-red; in older usage it can also describe a temperament or complexion.

### **Sapphism**

Sapphism is an historical term for sexual or romantic relationships between women; respectful modern language generally uses lesbian or same-sex relationships.

### **Scaling**

Scaling is flaking or shedding of the outer skin layer and may occur with dryness, eczema, psoriasis, fungal infection, or other skin disease.

### **Scan**

Scan is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Scarification**

Intentional scratching, cutting, or abrasion of skin, historically used in some inoculation or cultural practices and medically used in limited procedures; it can cause infection and scarring.

### **Scler-**

The term Scler- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Sclero-**

The term Sclero- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Sclerosis**

Abnormal hardening or scarring of tissue, often from excess connective tissue, chronic inflammation, degeneration, or neurologic plaques; the affected organ determines the specific disease.

### **Script**

A script is a written set of instructions or a prescription; in healthcare, a prescription specifies the medicine, dose, route, timing, and duration.

### **Scrofulous**

Scrofulous is an old term for tuberculous infection of lymph nodes, especially in the neck, which can cause chronic swelling and draining sinuses.

### **Scrub**

A scrub is vigorous cleaning or a garment worn in healthcare; clinical scrubbing reduces contamination when performed with the appropriate method and duration.

### **Scrub In**

To scrub in is to perform surgical hand antisepsis and put on sterile clothing and gloves before participating in a sterile procedure.

### **Scrub Up**

To scrub up means to clean and antiseptically pre-

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pare the hands and forearms before a sterile procedure.

### Scrubs

Scrubs are protective work garments commonly worn by healthcare staff; they reduce clothing contamination but do not replace hand hygiene or other precautions.

### Section

A defined part or subdivision of an organ, document, study, or procedure; in anatomy and imaging, the term identifies a specific slice or region examined.

### Section, Cesarean

Cesarean section, an operation delivering a baby through incisions in the abdomen and uterus when vaginal birth is unsafe, impossible, or not advisable.

### Seizure Disorders

Conditions characterized by recurrent unprovoked seizures or an enduring predisposition to them, classified by seizure type and cause and treated according to epilepsy syndrome and risk.

### Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### Semen DNA Analysis

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### Sense

A sense is a capacity to detect and interpret stimuli such as touch, temperature, pain, sound, light, smell, taste, position, or internal body signals.

### Septic

Relating to infection or contamination by pathogenic microorganisms; in “septic shock” it

refers to life-threatening circulatory and metabolic dysfunction caused by an abnormal response to infection.

### Septum, Heart

The wall separating the right and left chambers of the heart, consisting of atrial and ventricular portions and preventing normal mixing of oxygenated and deoxygenated blood.

### Sequela

A lasting consequence or condition that remains after an earlier disease, injury, infection, or treatment has ended, such as paralysis after stroke or scarring after infection.

### Sequester

To sequester means to isolate or set apart; in medicine, sequestered tissue or material is separated from its normal circulation or surroundings.

### Ser

Ser is the standard abbreviation for serine, an amino acid incorporated into proteins and involved in metabolism and cell signaling.

### Serendipity

Serendipity is an unexpected beneficial discovery; in research, it describes useful findings that arise while investigating another question.

### Serine

Serine is a nonessential amino acid used in protein synthesis, one-carbon metabolism, membrane formation, and signaling.

### Serositis

Inflammation of a serous membrane, such as the pleura, pericardium, or peritoneum, causing pain with breathing or movement and sometimes an inflammatory effusion.

### Serration

A row of small tooth-like projections or notches along an edge, used to describe anatomy, cells, in-

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struments, or imaging appearances.

### **Serum Glutamic Oxaloacetic Transaminase (SGOT)**

SGOT, now called AST, is an enzyme released by injured liver, heart, skeletal muscle, or other cells; its level must be interpreted with other findings.

### **Serum Glutamic Pyruvic Transaminase (SGPT)**

SGPT, now called ALT, is an enzyme concentrated in liver cells and commonly measured as a marker of hepatocellular injury.

### **Serving Size**

Serving size is the standardized amount used to describe the nutrients or calories in food and may differ from the amount a person actually eats.

### **Sesquipedalian**

Sesquipedalian means characterized by very long words; clear healthcare communication favors language that patients can understand.

### **Sexual Sadism**

Sexual sadism involves recurrent arousal from another person's suffering or humiliation; acts without consent are abuse, and safety-focused clinical care is required.

### **SGOT**

SGOT is the former abbreviation for AST, an enzyme measured in blood that can rise with injury to liver, heart, muscle, or other tissues.

### **SGPT**

SGPT is the former abbreviation for ALT, a liver-associated enzyme that rises in many forms of hepatocellular injury.

### **Shark Attack**

A shark attack can cause severe lacerations, bleeding, tissue loss, drowning, and shock; emergency rescue, hemorrhage control, and trauma care are critical.

### **Shin Bone Fever**

Shin bone fever refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Shin Spot**

A shin spot is a nonspecific mark or lesion on the lower leg; its significance depends on appearance, duration, symptoms, injury, and associated disease.

### **Ship Fever**

An historical term for epidemic typhus, a louse-borne infection caused by *Rickettsia prowazekii* and associated with crowding, fever, rash, and severe systemic illness.

### **Shock, Secondary**

Circulatory failure occurring as a consequence of another condition, such as infection, trauma, bleeding, heart failure, allergy, or endocrine crisis, with inadequate tissue perfusion.

### **Short Arm Of A Chromosome**

The p arm, or shorter arm, of a chromosome, named from the French *petit*; cytogenetic bands on this arm locate genes and chromosomal abnormalities.

### **Shotty**

Shotty describes small, firm, discrete lymph nodes, often reactive after infection; persistent, enlarging, hard, or generalized nodes require evaluation.

### **SHP**

SHP is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to a healthcare professional, a gene or protein, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be specified.

### **Siddha Medicine**

Siddha medicine is a traditional South Asian healing system using dietary, herbal, mineral, and other practices; products may have contamination, toxicity, or interaction risks.

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## Side Effects

Side effects are unintended effects of a medicine or treatment, ranging from mild symptoms to serious toxicity; risk depends on the product, dose, and patient.

## Sigmoid

Sigmoid means S-shaped; the sigmoid colon is the curved section of large intestine between the descending colon and rectum.

## Signature

A signature is a person's identifying mark or electronic confirmation of approval, consent, authorship, or verification.

## Silver Bullet

A medical term referring to silver bullet. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## Silver Poisoning

Silver poisoning, or argyria, follows excessive silver exposure and can cause permanent blue-gray skin discoloration and, rarely, organ or neurologic effects.

## Simian Crease

A simian crease is a single transverse crease across the palm, which may be a normal variant or occur with some chromosomal or developmental conditions.

## Situational Syncope

A reflex faint triggered by a specific situation such as coughing, urination, defecation, swallowing, laughter, or prolonged standing, caused by transient reduced cerebral perfusion.

## Six Fingers Or Toes

Six fingers or toes is polydactyly, a congenital extra-digit difference that may occur alone or as part of a genetic syndrome.

## Skeleton, Bones Of The

The body's framework of bones and cartilage, providing support, protection, leverage for movement,

mineral storage, and marrow-based blood-cell production.

## Skin Color

Skin color refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

## Skin Graft, Pedicle

Skin graft, pedicle refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

## Slanted Ear

Slanted ear refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

## SLE (Systemic Lupus Erythematosus)

Systemic lupus erythematosus is an autoimmune disease that can inflame skin, joints, kidneys, blood cells, nervous system, heart, or other organs.

## Sleep Drug

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to sleep drug; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

## Sliding Hiatal Hernia

A sliding hiatal hernia occurs when the stomach and gastroesophageal junction move upward through the diaphragm, often contributing to reflux.

## SLS (Sjogren-Larsson Syndrome)

A clinical condition involving sLS (Sjogren-Larsson Syndrome); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## SLV

SLV is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean single-lung ventilation, serum lithium value, or another term; the full meaning should be specified.



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### **Small Calorie (Calorie)**

A small calorie is a unit of heat energy; food labels usually use a kilocalorie, written Calorie with a capital C, equal to 1,000 small calories.

### **Small Eye**

Small eye refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Small Round Blue Cell Tumor**

Small round blue cell tumor refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Snort**

A snort is a forceful nasal or respiratory sound; it may occur with congestion, sleep-disordered breathing, irritation, or inhalation of a substance.

### **Snot**

Snot is an informal term for nasal mucus, which traps particles and helps protect the respiratory lining; its appearance changes with infection, allergy, and irritation.

### **Snuff**

Snuff is finely ground tobacco inhaled through the nose or placed in the mouth and can cause nicotine dependence, oral disease, and cardiovascular harm.

### **Sociophobia**

An older term for social anxiety disorder, involving excessive fear of scrutiny, embarrassment, humiliation, or negative evaluation in social or performance situations.

### **Somnolence**

Abnormal sleepiness or a tendency to fall asleep during wakeful periods, caused by insufficient sleep, medicines, sleep disorders, metabolic disease, or neurologic illness.

### **Somnolent**

Somnolent means unusually sleepy or drowsy, which may result from sleep deprivation, medicines, intoxication, metabolic illness, or neurologic disease.

### **Speculum, Ear**

Speculum, ear refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Speech-Language Pathologist**

A clinician who evaluates and treats disorders of speech, language, voice, communication, cognition, and swallowing across childhood, adulthood, and older age.

### **Speed**

Speed is an informal term for methamphetamine, a stimulant that can cause dependence, cardiovascular toxicity, psychosis, overheating, and other serious harms.

### **Spit**

Spit is saliva expelled from the mouth; increased saliva or repeated spitting may reflect oral irritation, nausea, reflux, swallowing difficulty, or behavior.

### **Spots In Front Of The Eyes**

Floaters or visual spots caused by shadows from vitreous opacities, inflammation, bleeding, retinal tears, migraine, or other eye or neurologic conditions; sudden flashes or a curtain-like loss are urgent.

### **Sprue, Nontropical**

A clinical finding or condition involving sprue, Nontropical; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Squamous Cells**

Flat epithelial cells with scale-like appearance that line surfaces such as skin, mouth, cervix, and esophagus; abnormal numbers or forms can reflect irritation, infection, dysplasia, or cancer.

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## SSRI

An SSRI is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor antidepressant used for depression and several anxiety-related disorders; effects and withdrawal symptoms require monitoring.

## St. Anthony's Fire

St. Anthony's fire is an historical name for ergot poisoning or, in some usage, erysipelas; modern diagnosis should identify the specific disease.

## Stasis Ulcer

A stasis ulcer is a chronic lower-leg wound caused by venous hypertension and poor return of blood, commonly near the ankle and associated with edema and skin changes.

## Stenotic

Stenotic means narrowed, as in a stenotic heart valve, blood vessel, airway, intestine, or other passage.

## Stereotactic

Stereotactic describes a technique using three-dimensional coordinates to target a precise location in the brain or another body structure.

## Sternutation

Sneezing, a reflex forceful expulsion of air through the nose and mouth triggered by irritation of nasal or upper-airway sensory receptors.

## Steroid Abuse

Steroid misuse is non-prescribed or excessive use of corticosteroids or anabolic-androgenic steroids, which can cause endocrine suppression, psychiatric effects, infection, metabolic disease, liver injury, cardiovascular harm, or tissue damage.

## STI

An STI is a sexually transmitted infection spread through sexual contact, including infections caused by bacteria, viruses, parasites, or fungi.

## Stiff Baby Syndrome

A clinical condition involving stiff Baby Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

## Stomach Cramps

Intermittent gripping or spasmodic upper-abdominal pain caused by gas, infection, indigestion, ulcer disease, gallbladder or pancreatic disease, obstruction, or other causes.

## Stomach Fat (Belly Fat, Abdominal Fat)

Adipose tissue stored beneath the skin or around abdominal organs; excess visceral fat is metabolically active and associated with insulin resistance, fatty liver, and cardiovascular risk.

## Stomach Paralysis

Stomach paralysis, or gastroparesis, is delayed emptying of stomach contents without obstruction, causing early fullness, nausea, vomiting, and bloating.

## Stool

Fecal material expelled from the bowel, composed of water, undigested residue, bacteria, cells, mucus, and bile pigments; color, form, frequency, and blood can provide clinical clues.

## Stool Occult Blood Test

Stool occult blood test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

## Streptococcus Pneumoniae (Pneumococcus)

Streptococcus pneumoniae (pneumococcus) is a biological organism or infectious agent; its clinical importance depends on the species, host, site, exposure, and evidence of infection or colonization.

## Stroke Index

Stroke index is a laboratory test, imaging method, instrument, score, or measurement used to characterize a specimen or clinical finding; interpretation

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depends on the method and clinical context.

### **STS**

STS is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean soft-tissue sarcoma, sodium thiosulfate, or another clinical term; the full term should be stated.

### **Study Population**

The defined group of people included in a research study, selected according to eligibility criteria and used to estimate effects, associations, or outcomes.

### **Stuffy Nose**

Stuffy nose refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Subaortic Stenosis**

Narrowing of the left-ventricular outflow tract just below the aortic valve, often caused by a fibrous ridge or tunnel and producing a pressure gradient, murmur, and possible aortic-valve injury.

### **Subclinical Disease**

A clinical condition involving subclinical Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Subcu**

Subcu is an abbreviation for subcutaneous, meaning beneath the skin; clear clinical instructions should spell out the route.

### **Subjacent**

Subjacent means lying directly beneath or below another structure.

### **Sublingual**

Sublingual means beneath the tongue; medicines given this way can be absorbed through oral mucosa and may bypass much first-pass liver metabolism.

### **Subq**

Subq is an abbreviation for subcutaneous, referring to tissue beneath the skin and the route used for

some injections.

### **Substance**

A substance is a material with defined or variable chemical composition; medical effects depend on identity, dose, route, duration, and host factors.

### **Subway Diet**

A commercial weight-loss approach emphasizing low-calorie meals from a restaurant chain; healthfulness depends on total nutrients, sodium, portion size, sustainability, and individual medical needs.

### **Succenturiate Placenta**

A succenturiate placenta has one or more accessory lobes separate from the main placenta, which can increase risk of retained tissue or fetal-vessel injury.

### **Succumb**

To succumb means to die from or be overcome by a disease, injury, exposure, or other serious process.

### **Sulfite Sensitivity**

Sulfite sensitivity is an adverse reaction to sulfite preservatives, sometimes causing wheeze, flushing, headache, or other symptoms, especially in people with asthma.

### **Sulfonamides**

Sulfonamides are drugs containing a sulfonamide group, including antibacterial agents that inhibit bacterial folate synthesis; allergic reactions, severe skin reactions, cytopenias, renal effects, and crystal-luria are possible.

### **Sulfonylurea**

A sulfonylurea is an oral diabetes medicine that closes pancreatic beta-cell ATP-sensitive potassium channels and stimulates insulin release; hypoglycaemia and weight gain are the main class risks.

### **Sundowning**

Late-day or evening worsening of confusion, agitation, wandering, or behavioral symptoms in some people with dementia or delirium, influenced by

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fatigue, light, routines, and unmet needs.

### **Sunflower Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving sunflower Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Superaspirin**

Superaspirin is an informal term for selective COX-2 inhibitors or other anti-inflammatory drugs developed to reduce gastrointestinal effects; cardiovascular risks remain relevant.

### **Superbug**

A superbug is an informal term for a microorganism resistant to multiple antimicrobial drugs, making infection harder to treat and prevent from spreading.

### **Surrogacy**

Surrogacy is an arrangement in which a person carries a pregnancy for intended parent or parents; medical, legal, ethical, and psychosocial requirements vary by jurisdiction.

### **Swallowing Syncope**

A medical term referring to swallowing syncope. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Sweat Gland Tumor**

A biomedical term referring to sweat gland tumor; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Sweating, Gustatory**

Sweating triggered by eating or smelling food, usually over the cheek or temple after parotid-nerve injury or surgery and known as Frey syndrome.

### **Swollen Tongue**

Swollen tongue refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Symptomatic Treatment**

Symptomatic treatment is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Syncope, Coughing**

A brief faint caused by coughing, which raises chest pressure, reduces venous return and cardiac output, and transiently lowers cerebral blood flow.

### **Syndemic**

A syndemic is the interaction of two or more diseases with social or environmental conditions that together worsen health outcomes.

### **Syndrome, Nervous Colon**

A clinical condition involving syndrome, Nervous Colon; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Syndrome, Post-Polio (PPS)**

A clinical condition involving syndrome, Post-Polio (PPS); its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Syndrome, TAR**

A clinical condition involving syndrome, TAR; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Synesthete**

A synesthete is a person who experiences synesthesia, in which stimulation of one sense or cognitive pathway automatically evokes another perception.

### **Systolic**

Systolic means relating to contraction of the heart, especially the pressure in arteries when the ventricles eject blood.

### **Sz**

Sz is an informal abbreviation for seizure; clinical documentation should identify the seizure type and relevant features clearly.

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### **Spontaneous Abortion (Miscarriage)**

Unintentional loss of a pregnancy before fetal viability. Causes include chromosomal abnormalities, uterine or cervical problems, infection, and maternal medical conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Miscarriage

### **Shellfish Allergy**

An immune reaction to proteins in crustaceans or mollusks that can cause hives, digestive or respiratory symptoms, or anaphylaxis.

### **Social Anxiety Disorder (Social Phobia)**

Intense fear and avoidance of social or performance situations because of concern about embarrassment, judgment, or scrutiny.

#### **Synonyms:**

Phobia, Social

### **Squamous Cell Carcinoma Of The Skin**

A skin cancer arising from squamous cells, often appearing as a scaly, crusted, wart-like, or ulcerated growth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Squamous Cell

### **Sudden Cardiac Arrest**

An abrupt loss of effective heart activity, causing unresponsiveness and absent or abnormal breathing; it is a medical emergency.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cardiac Arrest, Sudden

### **Swimmer's Itch**

An itchy rash caused by an allergic reaction to microscopic parasites released by infected snails in freshwater or saltwater.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cercarial Dermatitis Dermatitis, Cercarial

### **Small Vessel Disease**

Disease affecting small blood vessels, which can impair blood flow and contribute to brain, heart, kidney, or other organ problems.

#### **Synonyms:**

Coronary Microvascular Disease

### **Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS)**

The unexplained sudden death of an apparently healthy infant, usually during sleep and before one year of age.

#### **Synonyms:**

Crib Death

### **Self-Injury/Cutting**

Deliberate injury to one's own body, often used to cope with overwhelming emotions and requiring compassionate assessment of safety and mental health.

#### **Synonyms:**

Self Harming

### **Sweating And Body Odor**

Excess perspiration or noticeable odor produced when skin bacteria break down sweat; it may be influenced by hygiene, diet, medicines, hormones, or disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Body Odor And Sweating

### **Subconjunctival Hemorrhage (Broken Blood Vessel In Eye)**

A small blood vessel broken beneath the clear surface of the eye, causing a sharply demarcated red patch that usually resolves without treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Broken Blood Vessel In Eye

### **Seborrheic Keratosis**

A common benign, usually pigmented, raised skin growth with a waxy or stuck-on appearance.

### **Subchorionic Hemorrhage**

Bleeding between the chorion and the uterine wall caused by partial separation of the gestational sac membranes. It may produce vaginal bleeding in early or mid-pregnancy and is assessed according to bleeding, gestational age, and ultrasound findings.

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## Sensory Processing Disorder

Difficulty detecting, interpreting, or responding to sensory input such as sound, touch, movement, light, or body position. It may affect behavior, learning, coordination, or daily activities and can occur with other neurodevelopmental conditions. Assessment and occupational-therapy strategies are individualized.

## Stasis Dermatitis

Inflammation of the lower-leg skin caused by chronic venous hypertension and edema. It may cause itching, redness, scaling, brown discoloration, weeping, or ulcers around the ankles. Management focuses on treating venous disease, compression when safe, skin care, and evaluation for infection or arterial insufficiency.

## Spontaneous Coronary Artery Dissection (SCAD)

A non-traumatic, non-iatrogenic separation within the wall of a coronary artery, usually caused by an intramural hematoma or an intimal tear. It can obstruct coronary blood flow and cause acute coronary syndrome, especially in younger or peripartum women; diagnosis and management require specialist cardiovascular assessment.

### Synonyms:

SCAD

## Cardiac Cachexia

A severe wasting syndrome associated with advanced heart failure or other serious cardiac disease, characterized by involuntary weight loss, skeletal-muscle loss, weakness, and reduced functional capacity. It reflects neurohormonal, inflammatory, metabolic, and nutritional abnormalities and is associated with poor prognosis.

## Scale

Visible flakes or plates of stratum corneum shed from the skin surface, commonly caused by abnormal keratinization, inflammation, infection, or dryness.

## Seborrheic

Relating to increased or altered activity of sebaceous glands or to areas rich in these glands, such as the scalp, face, chest, and upper back.

## Serologic Test

A blood test that detects antibodies, antigens, or other immune markers to help diagnose infection, assess immunity, or monitor response to treatment.

## Subclinical Infection

An infection that produces no noticeable symptoms or signs but may still be detectable by testing and may sometimes be transmissible.

## Sjögren's Disease

Alternate index label; see *Sjögren's Syndrome*.

## Shift Work Sleep Disorder

A circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorder caused by work schedules that overlap the usual sleep period, producing insomnia, excessive sleepiness, or both.

## Sleep Debt

The accumulated difference between the amount of sleep a person needs and the amount obtained over time; it may impair alertness, mood, cognition, and performance.

## Sleep Diary

A daily record of sleep and wake times, awakenings, naps, medicines, caffeine, and related factors used to assess sleep patterns and treatment response.

## Sleep Efficiency

The percentage of time spent asleep while in bed, calculated as total sleep time divided by time in bed and multiplied by 100.

## Sleep Fragmentation

Repeated brief awakenings or arousals that interrupt otherwise continuous sleep and may reduce restorative sleep.



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### **Sleep Onset Latency**

The time required to fall asleep after attempting to sleep; prolonged latency may occur with insomnia, anxiety, circadian misalignment, stimulants, or another sleep disorder.

### **Sleep-Related Hypoxemia**

Abnormally low blood oxygen during sleep that may occur with sleep-disordered breathing, lung disease, neuromuscular weakness, hypoventilation, or other medical conditions.

### **Sedative-Hypnotic Toxicodrome**

A poisoning pattern caused by central nervous system depressants, producing drowsiness, slurred speech, impaired coordination, reduced reflexes, respiratory depression, coma, or loss of airway protection.

### **Sympathomimetic Toxicodrome**

A poisoning pattern caused by excessive adrenergic stimulation, producing agitation, sweating, dilated pupils, rapid heart rate, high blood pressure, elevated temperature, tremor, or seizures.

### **Silicone Implants**

Medical implants containing silicone gel or elastomer used for breast reconstruction or augmentation; complications may include rupture, capsular contracture, infection, malposition, or need for revision.

### **Soft Tissue Augmentation**

Restoration or enhancement of volume and contour in skin or underlying soft tissue using fillers, fat transfer, implants, or other reconstructive techniques.

### **Sebaceous Hyperplasia**

A benign enlargement of sebaceous glands, presenting as small yellowish papules with central umbilication, usually on the face of adults.

### **Spiradenoma**

A usually benign painful sweat-gland tumor present-

ing as a dermal nodule; multiple spiradenomas may occur in Brooke-Spiegler syndrome.

### **Spiradenocarcinoma**

A rare malignant sweat-gland tumor that may arise in a long-standing spiradenoma, presenting as a rapidly enlarging, painful, or ulcerated nodule.

### **Spitz Nevus**

A benign melanocytic nevus, often a pink or pigmented papule in children or young adults, that may resemble melanoma clinically or histologically.

### **Superficial Spreading Melanoma**

The most common cutaneous melanoma subtype, characterized initially by radial growth across the epidermis and an irregularly pigmented patch or plaque before invasion develops.

### **Syringocystadenoma Papilliferum**

A benign adnexal tumor with apocrine or eccrine differentiation, often presenting as a papule or plaque on the scalp or face and sometimes arising within a nevus sebaceus.

### **Sister Mary Joseph Nodule**

A metastatic tumor deposit in or around the umbilicus, usually from an intra-abdominal or pelvic malignancy.

### **Silicone Mastitis**

A granulomatous inflammatory reaction to silicone released from a breast implant or injected silicone. It may cause nodules, pain, lymphadenopathy, or imaging findings that mimic malignancy.

### **Sebaceous Epithelioma**

A benign sebaceous neoplasm, often presenting as a yellowish papule or nodule. Multiple or unusual lesions may warrant assessment for a DNA mismatch-repair syndrome such as Muir-Torre syndrome.

### **Small Bowel Adenocarcinoma**

A malignant gland-forming epithelial tumor of the small intestine. It is uncommon and may cause

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occult bleeding, obstruction, abdominal pain, or weight loss; risk is increased in selected inherited and inflammatory disorders.

### **Subependymal Giant Cell Astrocytoma**

A usually low-grade astrocytic tumor arising near the foramen of Monro, strongly associated with tuberous sclerosis complex. It may obstruct cerebrospinal-fluid flow and cause hydrocephalus.

### **Subependymoma**

A rare, usually benign slow-growing ependymal tumor, commonly arising in the ventricular system of adults. Symptoms result from obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid pathways or incidental detection.

### **Subungual Exostosis**

A benign osteocartilaginous outgrowth arising beneath the nail, usually of a toe or finger. It causes a painful firm subungual mass and nail deformity and is treated by excision when symptomatic.

### **Synovial Reaction To Implanted Prostheses**

Inflammation and tissue response around an orthopedic implant caused by wear particles, loosening, corrosion, infection, or hypersensitivity. Evaluation distinguishes aseptic failure from periprosthetic infection.

### **Scheuermann Disease**

A juvenile osteochondrosis of the spine in which vertebral end plates develop irregularities and anterior wedging during skeletal growth. It commonly produces a rigid thoracic kyphosis, although the thoracolumbar or lumbar spine may also be involved. Symptoms can include back pain, fatigue, limited spinal motion, and postural deformity that becomes more apparent during adolescence. Diagnosis is based on clinical examination and characteristic radiographs; management depends on deformity severity, skeletal maturity, pain, and progression.

### **Subdural Hemorrhage**

Accumulation of blood between the dura mater and arachnoid membrane, usually caused by tearing of

bridging veins after head trauma. Acute hemorrhage may produce rapid neurological deterioration, whereas chronic hemorrhage can develop gradually, particularly in older adults or patients with cerebral atrophy. Clinical features include headache, confusion, drowsiness, focal neurological deficits, seizures, or loss of consciousness. Diagnosis is established with neuroimaging, usually computed tomography, and treatment ranges from observation to surgical evacuation according to size, symptoms, and mass effect.

## T

### Term

The end of pregnancy at 37 completed weeks of gestation; births before this are classified as preterm.

### Tabes

An older term for tabes dorsalis, a late neurologic complication of untreated syphilis.

### TAB Vaccine

An older combined vaccine against typhoid and paratyphoid A and B.

### Tacalcitol

A vitamin-D analogue used topically for psoriasis and selected disorders of keratinization.

### Tacrolimus

An immunosuppressant that inhibits calcineurin; used systemically after transplantation and topically for eczema.

### Tactile

Relating to touch or the sense of touch.

### Taenia

A genus of tapeworms, including *T. solium* and *T. saginata*.

### Taeniasis

Intestinal infection caused by adult *Taenia* tapeworms.

### Talc

A soft mineral; inhalation of talc dust can cause talcosis, and contaminated injected talc can injure

vessels and lungs.

### Talipes

A congenital or acquired deformity of the foot and ankle, including clubfoot.

### Tamoxifen

A selective estrogen-receptor modulator used mainly to treat or prevent selected breast cancers.

### Tampon

A material inserted into the vagina to absorb menstrual blood; prolonged use can rarely lead to toxic shock syndrome.

### Tamponade

Compression of an organ or vessel by accumulated fluid, blood, or gas; cardiac tamponade impairs cardiac filling.

### Tantulum

A misspelling of tantalum, a metal used in selected implants and medical devices.

### Tapotement

A massage technique involving rhythmic tapping or percussion.

### Tapping

Repeated light striking or percussion used in examination, therapy, or testing.

### Target Cell

A cell specifically affected by or responding to a hormone, drug, toxin, antigen, or other signal; target

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cells may also describe abnormal erythrocytes.

### **Target Organ**

An organ particularly affected by a disease, hormone, toxin, drug, or other exposure.

### **Tars**

A viscous black material derived from organic matter; tobacco tar contains harmful chemicals.

### **Tarsal**

Relating to the tarsus or ankle and hindfoot bones.

### **Tarsus**

The group of seven bones forming the hindfoot and midfoot.

### **Tartar**

A hard deposit of mineralized dental plaque, also called calculus.

### **Tattooing**

Insertion of pigment into the skin; complications include infection, allergy, scarring, and difficulty interpreting lesions.

### **Taxanes**

A class of chemotherapy medicines, including paclitaxel and docetaxel, that stabilize microtubules.

### **Taxis**

Directed movement toward or away from a stimulus; in surgery it may also mean orderly repositioning.

### **Tazarotene**

A topical retinoid used for acne, psoriasis, and photoaging.

### **T-Cell Lymphoma**

A lymphoma arising from T lymphocytes, with multiple biologically distinct subtypes.

### **Tears**

Fluid secreted by the lacrimal glands that lubricates,

nourishes, and protects the ocular surface.

### **Technetium-99**

A radioactive isotope related to technetium-99m; technetium isotopes are used in nuclear medicine and radioactive decay studies.

### **Teeth, Disorders Of**

Conditions affecting teeth, including caries, developmental defects, infection, trauma, malocclusion, and tumors.

### **Teeth-Grinding**

Bruxism, repetitive clenching or grinding of teeth, often during sleep and capable of causing tooth wear and jaw pain.

### **Teichopsia**

A visual disturbance involving shimmering or fortification spectra, commonly occurring as a migraine aura.

### **Teicoplanin**

A glycopeptide antibiotic used for selected serious gram-positive infections.

### **Telangiectasis**

Dilation of small superficial blood vessels, producing visible red or purple lines or patches.

### **Temazepam**

A benzodiazepine hypnotic used short term for insomnia; sedation, dependence, and respiratory depression are risks.

### **Temperature Scales**

Systems for expressing temperature, including Celsius, Fahrenheit, and Kelvin.

### **Temple**

The region of the skull at the side of the head between the forehead and ear.

### **Temporal**

Relating to time or to the side of the skull and

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temporal lobe.

### **Temporal Artery**

An artery on the side of the scalp, especially the superficial temporal artery.

### **Tenderness**

Pain or discomfort produced by pressing a body part.

### **Teno-**

A combining form relating to a tendon.

### **Tenotomy**

Surgical cutting or division of a tendon.

### **Tenovaginitis**

Inflammation of a tendon and its surrounding sheath, also called tenosynovitis.

### **TENS**

Transcutaneous electrical nerve stimulation, using skin electrodes to deliver electrical pulses for pain modulation.

### **Tentorium**

A fold of dura mater separating the cerebellum from the occipital lobes.

### **Teratogenesis**

The production of congenital abnormalities by genetic, environmental, infectious, nutritional, or drug-related influences.

### **Terbutaline**

A beta-2 agonist used as a bronchodilator; it has limited and specialist use as a tocolytic.

### **Tertian Fever**

A fever pattern recurring approximately every 48 hours, classically associated with *Plasmodium vivax* or *P. falciparum* malaria.

### **Testicle**

A male gonad that produces sperm and testosterone.

### **Testicle, Diseases Of**

Disorders of the testis, including torsion, infection, trauma, tumors, vascular disease, and developmental abnormalities.

### **Test Meal**

A standardized meal given before measuring a physiologic response, such as gastric acid or glucose handling.

### **Test-Tube**

A laboratory glass or plastic vessel used to contain, mix, or test small samples.

### **Test-Tube Baby**

A lay term for a baby conceived through in-vitro fertilization.

### **Tetrabenazine**

A vesicular monoamine transporter 2 inhibitor used for selected hyperkinetic movement disorders.

### **Tetralogy Of Fallot (TOF)**

A congenital heart defect comprising ventricular septal defect, right-ventricular outflow obstruction, overriding aorta, and right-ventricular hypertrophy.

### **Tetraplegia**

Paralysis or severe weakness of all four limbs, usually from cervical spinal-cord disease or injury.

### **Thalassaemia**

The British spelling of thalassemia, inherited reduced production of alpha- or beta-globin chains causing anemia.

### **Thalidomide**

An immunomodulatory medicine used for selected cancers and inflammatory disorders; it is strongly teratogenic.

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**Theca**

A connective-tissue sheath, especially the theca surrounding an ovarian follicle.

**Thenar Eminence**

The fleshy muscular prominence at the base of the thumb.

**Theophylline**

A methylxanthine bronchodilator with a narrow therapeutic index and substantial interaction and toxicity risk.

**Thermo-**

A combining form relating to heat or temperature.

**Thermography**

Imaging or recording of heat patterns from the body surface.

**Thermoluminescent Dosimeter**

A radiation-monitoring device that measures accumulated exposure by light released from an irradiated crystal when heated.

**Thermometer Scales**

Temperature measurement systems such as Celsius, Fahrenheit, and Kelvin.

**Thermoreceptor**

A sensory receptor detecting warmth or cold.

**Thiabendazole**

An anthelmintic used for selected worm infections and, historically, some fungal infections.

**Thiazides**

Diuretics that inhibit sodium-chloride reabsorption in the distal convoluted tubule.

**Thiazolidinedione Drugs**

Insulin-sensitizing medicines that activate PPAR- $\gamma$ , including pioglitazone.

**Thigh**

The part of the lower limb between the hip and knee.

**Thiopentone Sodium**

A short-acting barbiturate anesthetic used for induction in selected settings.

**Thioridazine**

An older phenothiazine antipsychotic with important cardiac and neurologic toxicity.

**Thiotepa**

An alkylating chemotherapy medicine used in selected cancers and conditioning regimens.

**Thirst**

The conscious desire to drink, regulated largely by osmolality and circulating volume.

**Thought Disorders**

Disturbances of the form, flow, or content of thinking, occurring in psychosis and other conditions.

**Threadworm**

An intestinal infection or the worm *Enterobius vermicularis*, also called pinworm.

**Threonine**

An essential amino acid incorporated into proteins.

**Threshold**

The minimum stimulus or level required to produce a detectable response or effect.

**Thrill**

A palpable vibration over the chest or a blood vessel caused by turbulent blood flow.

**Throat**

The pharynx and adjacent structures behind the mouth and nose.



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### **Throbbing**

A pulsating or beating quality of pain or sensation.

### **Thrombin**

A coagulation enzyme that converts fibrinogen to fibrin and activates platelets.

### **Thromboangiitis Obliterans**

Buerger disease, an inflammatory tobacco-associated disease of small and medium arteries and veins.

### **Thrombocyte**

Another name for a platelet.

### **Thrombocytopenia**

A misspelling of thrombocytopenia, an abnormally low platelet count.

### **Thrombocytopenic**

Characterized by a reduced number of circulating platelets.

### **Thrombolytic Agents**

Medicines that dissolve blood clots by converting plasminogen to plasmin.

### **Thromboxane**

A lipid mediator produced by platelets that promotes platelet aggregation and vasoconstriction.

### **Thrombus**

A blood clot formed within a blood vessel or heart during life.

### **Thumb-Sucking**

A common childhood habit of sucking the thumb; persistent habit can affect dental and facial development.

### **Thymocyte**

An immature T lymphocyte developing in the thymus.

### **Thymus Gland**

A lymphoid organ in the chest where T lymphocytes mature.

### **Thyroid Gland, Diseases Of**

Disorders of the thyroid, including hypothyroidism, hyperthyroidism, inflammation, nodules, and cancer.

### **Thyroidectomy**

Surgical removal of part or all of the thyroid gland.

### **Thyrotoxicosis**

The clinical state caused by excessive circulating thyroid hormone, regardless of source.

### **Thyrotrophin-Releasing Hormone (TRH)**

A hypothalamic hormone that stimulates pituitary release of TSH and prolactin.

### **Thyrotrophin-Stimulating Hormone (TSH)**

Thyroid-stimulating hormone, a pituitary hormone that stimulates thyroid hormone production.

### **Tic**

A sudden, rapid, recurrent, nonrhythmic movement or vocalization.

### **Ticks**

Small arachnids that attach to skin and may transmit infections or cause tick paralysis.

### **Synonyms:**

Ticks Bite (Ticks)

### **Timolol Maleate**

The maleate salt of timolol, a beta blocker used in glaucoma and selected cardiovascular conditions.

### **Tissue Plasminogen Activator (TPA, TPA)**

An enzyme or recombinant medicine that converts plasminogen to plasmin and dissolves clots.

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## **Tissues Of The Body**

Groups of similar cells and extracellular material performing a common function: epithelial, connective, muscle, and nervous tissue.

## **Tidy Wound**

A clean, sharply incised wound with minimal contamination, crushing, or tissue devitalization and clearly defined viable edges. After appropriate assessment and cleaning, it may often be closed primarily.

## **Tissue Typing**

Testing tissue antigens, especially HLA, to assess compatibility for transplantation.

## **Titration**

Gradual adjustment of a medicine dose or measurement of a substance using a reagent of known concentration.

## **Titre**

The concentration or level of an antibody or other substance measured by serial dilution.

## **Titubation**

A rhythmic nodding or tremulous movement, especially of the head or trunk, often associated with cerebellar disease.

## **Tizanidine**

A centrally acting alpha-2 agonist used to reduce painful muscle spasm and spasticity.

## **T-Lymphocyte**

A lymphocyte that matures in the thymus and mediates cellular immune responses.

## **TNM Classification**

A cancer-staging system describing primary tumor size or extent, regional nodes, and distant metastasis.

## **Tobacco**

The plant and its products containing nicotine and

many toxic chemicals; use causes addiction and major disease risk.

## **Tobramycin**

An aminoglycoside antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections, including some gram-negative infections.

## **Toes**

The digits of the foot.

## **Tolazomide**

An older sulfonylurea medicine used to lower blood glucose in type 2 diabetes.

## **Tolbutamide**

An older first-generation sulfonylurea used for type 2 diabetes.

## **Tolerance**

Reduced response to a drug or exposure after repeated use, requiring greater exposure for the same effect.

## **Tomography**

Imaging that produces sectional views through the body.

## **-Tomy**

A suffix meaning incision or cutting into.

## **Tongue**

A muscular organ involved in taste, speech, chewing, and swallowing.

## **Tongue, Disorders Of**

Conditions affecting the tongue, including infection, inflammation, trauma, tumors, and developmental abnormalities.

## **Tonics**

Preparations traditionally claimed to invigorate or strengthen; their contents and evidence vary.

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**Tonsil**

A mass of lymphoid tissue at the entrance to the pharynx.

**Tonsillitis**

Inflammation or infection of the tonsils, commonly viral or streptococcal.

**Tooth**

A mineralized structure in the jaw used for cutting, tearing, and grinding food.

**Tooth, Supernumerary**

An extra tooth beyond the normal number, which may cause crowding or impaction.

**Toothache**

Pain arising from a tooth or its supporting tissues.

**Tophus**

A deposit of monosodium urate crystals in gout, often around joints or in soft tissues.

**Torpor**

A state of reduced activity, alertness, or responsiveness.

**Torsion**

Twisting of a structure around its axis, potentially cutting off blood supply.

**Torticollis**

Abnormal contraction or posture of the neck causing the head to tilt or rotate.

**Touch**

The sensory perception of contact, pressure, texture, or vibration.

**Tourette's Syndrome**

A neurodevelopmental disorder involving multiple motor tics and at least one vocal tic persisting for more than one year.

**Tourniquet**

A device or band used to compress a limb and temporarily reduce blood flow.

**Toxaemia**

An older term for toxins in the blood or systemic illness; in pregnancy it was historically used for pre-eclampsia.

**Toxbase**

A clinical toxicology information service used to support assessment and management of poisoning.

**Toxicology**

The study of poisons, toxic exposures, their effects, prevention, and treatment.

**Toxic Shock Syndrome**

A severe toxin-mediated illness, usually caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* or *Streptococcus pyogenes*, with fever, rash, hypotension, and organ dysfunction.

**Toxins**

Poisonous substances produced by living organisms.

**Toxocariasis**

A zoonotic infection caused by *Toxocara* larvae, potentially affecting viscera or the eye.

**Toxoid**

A toxin rendered non-toxic but still antigenic, used in vaccines such as tetanus and diphtheria toxoids.

**Toxoplasmosis**

Infection by *Toxoplasma gondii*, usually mild but potentially severe in pregnancy or immunosuppression.

**Synonyms:**

Chorioretinitis *Toxoplasma* (Toxoplasmosis) Meningoencephalitis *Toxoplasma* (Toxoplasmosis)

**TPA/TPA**

Abbreviation for tissue plasminogen activator.

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### **Trabecula**

A small beam, strut, or partition of tissue, especially in cancellous bone.

### **Trace Elements**

Minerals required in very small amounts, including iron, zinc, copper, iodine, and selenium.

### **Tracer**

A labeled substance used to follow a biological, chemical, or physical process.

### **Trachea**

The windpipe connecting the larynx with the main bronchi.

### **Tracheitis**

Inflammation or infection of the trachea.

### **Tracheostomy**

A surgically created opening through the neck into the trachea, usually with insertion of a tube.

### **Trachoma**

A chronic eye infection caused by Chlamydia trachomatis that can scar the conjunctiva and cornea.

### **Traction**

A pulling force used to align, immobilize, or relieve pressure on tissue or a fracture.

### **Tractotomy**

Surgical interruption of a nerve tract, usually to reduce severe pain or other neurologic symptoms.

### **Training**

Structured acquisition of knowledge, skills, or physical capacity.

### **Trance**

An altered state of awareness; clinical interpretation depends on cause and context.

### **Tranexamic Acid**

An antifibrinolytic medicine that reduces bleeding by inhibiting plasminogen activation.

### **Tranquillisers**

An older term for medicines that reduce anxiety or agitation, including benzodiazepines and some antipsychotics.

### **Transcervical Resection Of Endometrium (TCRE)**

An endoscopic procedure that removes or ablates the endometrium to reduce heavy menstrual bleeding.

### **Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation (TENS)**

Electrical stimulation delivered through skin electrodes to modulate pain.

### **Transient Ischaemic Attacks Or Episodes (TIA, TIE)**

Brief focal neurologic episodes caused by temporary ischemia without persistent infarction.

### **Translocation**

Movement of a chromosome segment, cell, organ, or substance to a different position.

### **Trans-Sexualism**

An obsolete term historically used for transgender identity or transition; current respectful terminology is preferred.

### **Transudation**

Passage of low-protein fluid through a membrane because of pressure or osmotic imbalance.

### **Transurethral Resection**

Removal of tissue through an instrument passed along the urethra, commonly for prostate or bladder disease.

### **Transverse**

Running across or perpendicular to the long axis or midline.

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### **Transvestitism**

An obsolete term for cross-dressing; clothing expression alone is not a mental disorder.

### **Tranylecypromine**

A monoamine oxidase inhibitor antidepressant requiring careful interaction and dietary management.

### **Trapezium**

A carpal bone at the base of the thumb.

### **Trauma**

Physical injury caused by external force, or the psychological response to a distressing event.

### **Traumatology**

The study and treatment of physical injury and its consequences.

### **Travel Medicine**

Medical care concerned with prevention and treatment of health problems related to travel.

### **Travel Sickness**

Motion sickness caused by travel.

### **Tremor**

Involuntary rhythmic oscillation of a body part.

### **Trench Fever**

A louse-borne infection caused by *Bartonella quintana*, producing recurring fever and bone pain.

### **Trench Foot**

Cold and wet injury to the feet causing numbness, swelling, pain, and tissue damage.

### **Trendelenberg Position**

A position in which the patient lies supine with the feet higher than the head; clinical uses and risks depend on context.

### **Trepanning**

Drilling or cutting a circular opening in bone, espe-

cially the skull.

### **Trephining**

Another term for trepanning, creating a circular opening in bone.

### **Treponema**

A genus of spiral bacteria including *T. pallidum*, the cause of syphilis.

### **Triage**

Sorting patients by urgency and resource needs so those at greatest risk receive timely care.

### **Triamcinolone**

A synthetic glucocorticoid used topically, by injection, or in other formulations for inflammation.

### **Triceps**

A three-headed muscle, especially the triceps brachii that extends the elbow.

### **Trichiasis**

Inward misdirection of eyelashes so they rub against the eye.

### **Trichiniasis**

An infection caused by *Trichinella* larvae, acquired from undercooked meat.

### **Trichinosis**

Another name for trichiniasis, caused by *Trichinella* infection.

### **Tricho-**

A combining form relating to hair.

### **Trichoepithelioma**

A rare benign follicular adnexal tumor that usually presents as a skin-coloured papule or nodule on the face or scalp; it can resemble basal-cell carcinoma and may require histopathologic confirmation.

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### Trichomonas Vaginalis

A flagellated protozoan that causes trichomoniasis, a sexually transmitted infection.

### Trichomoniasis

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Trichomonas vaginalis*.

### Trichophyton

A genus of dermatophyte fungi causing infections of skin, hair, and nails.

### Trichotillomania

Recurrent compulsive pulling out of one's hair, causing hair loss and distress or impairment.

### Trichuriasis

Intestinal infection caused by the whipworm *Trichuris trichiura*.

### Tricuspid Incompetence

Failure of the tricuspid valve to close completely, causing regurgitation into the right atrium.

### Tricuspid Stenosis

Narrowing of the tricuspid valve opening, obstructing flow from right atrium to right ventricle.

### Tricuspid Valve

The right atrioventricular heart valve between the right atrium and right ventricle.

### Tricyclic Antidepressant Drugs

Antidepressants that inhibit norepinephrine and serotonin reuptake and can cause anticholinergic, cardiac, and toxic effects.

### Trifluoperazine

A phenothiazine antipsychotic used for selected psychotic disorders.

### Trigeminal Nerve

Cranial nerve V, carrying facial sensation and motor supply to muscles of mastication.

### Trigeminal Neuralgia

Brief, severe, electric-shock-like facial pain in one or more trigeminal-nerve divisions.

#### Synonyms:

Neuralgia, Trigeminal Tic Douloureux (Trigeminal Neuralgia)

### Trigger Finger

Stenosing tenosynovitis causing painful catching or locking of a finger during movement.

#### Synonyms:

Stenosing Tenosynovitis Trigger Thumb (Trigger Finger)

### Trigger Thumb

Stenosing tenosynovitis causing painful catching or locking of the thumb.

### Triglyceride

A lipid composed of glycerol and three fatty acids, transported in blood and stored in adipose tissue.

### Trigone

A triangular area, especially the smooth region at the base of the urinary bladder.

### Tri-Iodothyronine

A misspelling of triiodothyronine, the thyroid hormone T3.

### Trimester

One of the three approximately three-month periods of pregnancy.

### Trimethoprim

An antibacterial medicine that inhibits bacterial folate metabolism, often combined with sulfamethoxazole.

### Trimipramine

A tricyclic antidepressant with sedative properties.

### Trinitrin

Another name for glyceryl trinitrate or nitroglycerin,



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a nitrate vasodilator.

### **Trinitrophenol**

Picric acid, a corrosive and explosive chemical historically used in medicine and industry.

### **Triples**

Three offspring born from the same pregnancy or three infants born in a multiple birth.

### **Trismus**

Restricted ability to open the mouth, commonly caused by tetanus, dental infection, or muscle spasm.

### **Trocar**

A pointed instrument in a cannula used to enter a body cavity or tissue.

### **Trochanter**

A bony prominence on the femur, especially the greater or lesser trochanter.

### **Trochlear Nerve**

Cranial nerve IV, supplying the superior oblique eye muscle.

### **Trophic**

Relating to nutrition, growth, or maintenance of tissue.

### **Trophoblast**

The outer layer of the early embryo that contributes to implantation and placenta formation.

### **Trophozoite**

The active, feeding, and multiplying stage of a protozoan parasite.

### **Tropical Diseases**

Diseases more common in tropical or subtropical regions, including malaria, dengue, and schistosomiasis.

### **Tropical Medicine**

The specialty concerned with diseases prevalent in tropical and subtropical regions and travel-related illness.

### **Tropical Ulcer**

A chronic ulcer occurring in tropical regions, often associated with infection, trauma, or poor wound healing.

### **Trunk**

The central part of the body excluding the head and limbs, or a major nerve or vessel trunk.

### **Truss**

A supportive appliance used historically for a hernia; definitive management depends on the type and complications.

### **Trypanosoma**

A genus of protozoan parasites causing African and American trypanosomiasis.

### **Trypanosomiasis**

Disease caused by Trypanosoma parasites, including African sleeping sickness and Chagas disease.

### **Trypsin**

A pancreatic protease secreted as trypsinogen and activated in the small intestine.

### **Tryptophan**

An essential amino acid and precursor of serotonin, melatonin, and niacin.

### **Tsetse Fly**

A biting fly of the Glossina genus that transmits African trypanosomes.

### **Tsutsugamushi Fever**

Scrub typhus, a mite-borne infection caused by Orientia tsutsugamushi.

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### **Tubal Pregnancy**

An ectopic pregnancy implanted in a fallopian tube.

### **Tubercle**

A small rounded projection or nodule; it may refer to bone anatomy or a tuberculous lesion.

### **Tuberculide**

A hypersensitivity skin eruption associated with underlying tuberculosis, usually without organisms in the lesions.

### **Tuberculin**

Protein material from *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* used in skin testing for immune sensitization.

### **Tuberculosis**

An infectious disease caused by *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, most often affecting the lungs.

#### **Synonyms:**

TB

### **Tuberous Sclerosis**

A genetic disorder causing benign tumors or hamartomas in multiple organs, including brain, skin, kidneys, and heart.

### **Tubocurarine**

A historical neuromuscular-blocking alkaloid derived from curare.

### **Tubule**

A small tube or tubular structure, such as a renal tubule.

### **Tularaemia**

A zoonotic infection caused by *Francisella tularensis*, acquired from animals, ticks, contaminated water, or aerosols.

### **Tulle Gras**

A paraffin-impregnated gauze dressing used to cover wounds and burns.

### **Tumescence**

Swelling or enlargement caused by engorgement with blood, fluid, or tissue growth.

### **Tumour**

A mass produced by abnormal cell growth; it may be benign or malignant.

### **Turgor**

The firmness of tissue produced by fluid pressure within cells; skin turgor can help assess dehydration.

### **Turner's Syndrome**

A chromosomal condition, usually involving complete or partial monosomy X, that typically affects phenotypic females. Common features include short stature, ovarian insufficiency with delayed or absent puberty and infertility, webbed neck, broad chest, congenital heart defects such as bicuspid aortic valve or coarctation of the aorta, and increased risk of autoimmune thyroid disease.

### **Twins**

Two offspring from the same pregnancy, either monozygotic or dizygotic.

### **Tympanic Membrane**

The eardrum, a thin membrane separating the external ear canal from the middle ear.

### **Tympanites**

Abdominal distension caused by gas in the intestine.

### **Tympanum**

The middle-ear cavity or, in some contexts, the tympanic membrane.

### **Typhoid Fever**

A systemic infection caused by *Salmonella Typhi*, transmitted through contaminated food or water.

#### **Synonyms:**

Enteric Fever (Typhoid Fever)

### **Typhus Fever**

A group of infections caused by *Rickettsia* species

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and transmitted mainly by lice or fleas.

### **Tyramine**

A naturally occurring amine in aged or fermented foods that can interact dangerously with monoamine oxidase inhibitors.

### **Tyrosine**

An amino acid used to make proteins, thyroid hormones, melanin, and catecholamines.

#### **Synonyms:**

Full term

### **Thoracic Surgeon**

Surgeon specializing in operations on the chest, including lungs, heart, esophagus, and mediastinum.

### **Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone**

A pituitary hormone that stimulates the thyroid to produce thyroid hormones.

#### **Synonyms:**

TSH

### **Thyroxine**

The main thyroid hormone containing four iodine atoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

T4

### **TIA**

A transient ischemic attack, a temporary episode of neurological dysfunction from reduced brain blood flow.

#### **Synonyms:**

Transient ischemic attack; mini-stroke

### **Ticlopidine**

An antiplatelet medicine that reduces platelet aggregation and clot formation.

### **Tolerable Upper Intake Level**

The highest usual daily nutrient intake unlikely to cause harm in nearly all healthy people.

#### **Synonyms:**

UL

### **Toll-Like Receptors**

Innate-immune receptors that detect characteristic microbial or tissue-danger signals.

#### **Synonyms:**

TLRs

### **Tonic**

A substance or preparation traditionally believed to invigorate or strengthen the body.

### **Tonometry**

Tonometry examines tonometry; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tooth Decay**

Destruction of tooth structure caused by acids produced by bacteria.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dental caries; cavities

### **Topical**

Applied directly to a body surface, usually the skin or a mucous membrane.

### **Toxic**

Poisonous or capable of causing injury to living tissue.

### **Toxic Nodular Goiter**

An enlarged thyroid with nodules that produce excessive thyroid hormone.

### **Toxin**

A poisonous substance produced by a living organism.

#### **Synonyms:**

Biological poison

### **TPA**

Tissue plasminogen activator, a clot-dissolving enzyme or medicine.

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**Synonyms:**

Tissue plasminogen activator

**Trabecular Bone**

Porous, lattice-like bone tissue found inside bones and near many joints.

**Synonyms:**

Spongy bone; cancellous bone

**Trabecular Meshwork**

A porous tissue in the eye through which aqueous humor drains.

**Trabeculoplasty**

Laser treatment that improves aqueous-humor drainage through the trabecular meshwork.

**Trace Mineral**

A mineral required by the body in very small amounts.

**Trans Fatty Acid**

An unsaturated fatty acid with trans configuration, often formed during industrial oil processing.

**Synonyms:**

Trans fat

**Transcranial Doppler Scanning**

Ultrasound measurement of blood flow through major arteries at the base of the brain.

**Synonyms:**

Transcranial Doppler; TCD

**Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation**

Low-voltage electrical stimulation delivered through skin electrodes to reduce pain.

**Synonyms:**

TENS

**Transferrin Saturation**

The percentage of transferrin iron-binding sites occupied by iron.

**Synonyms:**

TSAT

**Transfusion**

Administration of donated blood or blood components into a person's circulation.

**Transient Pain**

Pain that is brief and resolves rather than persisting.

**Transmural Infarction**

A heart attack involving the full thickness of part of the heart wall.

**Transplantation**

Transfer of an organ, tissue, or cells from a donor to a recipient.

**Synonyms:**

Transplant

**Transrectal Ultrasonography**

Ultrasound imaging of the prostate or nearby structures using a rectal probe.

**Synonyms:**

TRUS

**Transurethral Incision Of The Prostate**

An operation using small prostate incisions to relieve obstruction of urine flow.

**Synonyms:**

TUIP

**Transurethral Microwave Thermotherapy**

Heat treatment using microwaves to destroy prostate tissue obstructing urine flow.

**Synonyms:**

TUMT

**Transurethral Needle Ablation**

Treatment using radiofrequency heat delivered by needles to destroy obstructing prostate tissue.

**Synonyms:**

TUNA

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## **T Wave**

The electrocardiographic deflection representing ventricular repolarization. Its shape and direction vary by lead and clinical context. Abnormal T waves may occur with ischemia, electrolyte disorders, ventricular strain, or other conditions.

## **T-Cell Lymphomas**

Lymphomas arising from mature or immature T lymphocytes. They include several biologically distinct diseases that may involve lymph nodes, skin, blood, or other organs; behavior and treatment depend on the subtype.

## **T-Cell Receptor**

A clonally distributed receptor on T lymphocytes that recognizes a peptide antigen presented by a major histocompatibility complex molecule. TCR signaling requires accessory and co-stimulatory signals for effective T-cell activation.

## **T-Cells (T-Lymphocytes)**

A type of lymphocyte that matures in the thymus and is the central effector of cell-mediated immunity. T-cells express the T-cell receptor (TCR) on their surface, which recognises peptide antigens presented by major histocompatibility complex (MHC) molecules on antigen-presenting cells.

### **Synonyms:**

T-Lymphocytes

## **T3**

Triiodothyronine, the most biologically active thyroid hormone, produced by deiodination of T4 in peripheral tissues (liver, kidney) and secreted by the thyroid. Regulates metabolism (BMR), protein/carbohydrate/lipid metabolism, growth, and development.

## **T4**

Thyroxine, the main hormone secreted by the thyroid gland (thyroxine, 80-90 percent of secretion), converted to the active T3 in tissues. Bound largely to thyroxine-binding globulin (TBG); free T4 is the active unbound fraction. Regulates metabolism, growth, and development.

## **Tabes Dorsalis**

A late manifestation of untreated syphilis in which degeneration of dorsal spinal-cord columns and roots causes sensory ataxia, lightning pains, loss of position sense, areflexia, and bladder or sexual dysfunction.

## **Tablet**

A solid dosage form of compressed drug plus excipients (binders, fillers, disintegrants, lubricants, coatings). Types: immediate-release, enteric-coated (resistant to gastric acid), sustained/controlled-release, sublingual, buccal, effervescent, chewable, and orally disintegrating.

## **Tachyarrhythmia**

An abnormally fast heart rhythm, which may arise from the atria, ventricles, or the heart's conduction system. Symptoms can include palpitations, dizziness, chest discomfort, shortness of breath, or fainting; fainting or severe symptoms require urgent assessment.

## **Tachycardia**

A faster-than-expected heart rate that may be a normal response or a sign of disease. See Fast Heart Rate.

### **Synonyms:**

Rapid Heartbeat

## **Tachyphylaxis**

A rapid, acute decrease in response to a drug after repeated administration over a short period, distinct from tolerance which develops more gradually. Tachyphylaxis results from rapid depletion of neurotransmitter stores, receptor desensitization, or receptor downregulation.

## **Tachypnea**

Abnormally rapid respiratory rate (adult >20 breaths/min). Physiologic (exercise, anxiety) or pathologic: hypoxia, fever, sepsis, metabolic acidosis (Kussmaul), pulmonary embolism, pneumonia, heart failure, pain, and compensation for metabolic derangement.

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## Tachypnoea

Abnormally rapid breathing, defined as a respiratory rate >20 breaths per minute in adults (age-dependent: >60 in neonates, >40 in 1–12 months, >30 in 1–5 years, >20 in >5 years). Tachypnoea is a non-specific sign of respiratory or metabolic distress.

## Tachysystole (Uterine Hyperstimulation)

More than 5 contractions in 10 minutes averaged over 30 minutes, or contractions lasting  $\geq 2$  minutes. Tachysystole with fetal heart rate changes (late decelerations, prolonged deceleration, loss of variability) is more concerning. Causes: oxytocin (most common), prostaglandins (misoprostol > dinoprostone), and cocaine.

### Synonyms:

Uterine Hyperstimulation

## TACO

Transfusion-Associated Circulatory Overload, a complication of blood transfusion due to volume overload causing pulmonary edema. Risk factors: pre-existing cardiac or renal disease, extremes of age, large transfusion volume, rapid infusion rate.

## Tactile Fremitus

Vibrations transmitted through the lung to the chest wall, felt during palpation. It is increased in consolidation (pneumonia) due to better sound transmission through solid tissue. It is decreased in pleural effusion, pneumothorax, and atelectasis due to impaired transmission.

## Taeniasis (Tapeworm Infection)

Intestinal infection caused by adult *Taenia* tapeworms, usually acquired by eating undercooked meat containing larval cysts. *Taenia solium* and *Taenia saginata* are important species; *Taenia solium* eggs can also cause cysticercosis in tissues.

### Synonyms:

Tapeworm Infection

## Takayasu Arteritis

A chronic granulomatous vasculitis primarily affecting the aorta and its major branches, most com-

monly diagnosed in women under 50 years of age, particularly in Asian populations.

## Takayasu Disease

A large-vessel vasculitis that primarily affects the aorta and its major branches. It may cause limb claudication, weak or unequal pulses, blood-pressure differences, bruits, fever, fatigue, or arterial narrowing and aneurysms. Imaging and inflammatory assessment guide immunosuppressive and vascular treatment.

## Takayasu's Arteritis

A chronic granulomatous vasculitis of the aorta and its major branches, predominantly affecting young women of Asian descent. Causes arterial stenosis, occlusion, or aneurysm formation. Presents with limb claudication, absent pulses, bruit, hypertension, and constitutional symptoms. Treatment: corticosteroids and immunosuppressives.

## Takotsubo Cardiomyopathy

Transient left ventricular apical ballooning resembling a Japanese octopus trap (takotsubo), typically triggered by emotional or physical stress. ECG may show ST elevation mimicking STEMI. Coronary angiography shows no obstructive disease. Most patients recover normal ventricular function within weeks.

## Talcosis

Pneumoconiosis from talc dust inhalation or IV injection of crushed oral medications. Causes upper lobe nodular fibrosis. HRCT may show "galaxy sign" of calcified nodules.

## Talus

Second largest tarsal bone articulating with tibia/fibula proximally at the ankle. Approximately 60 percent of its surface is articular cartilage with no muscular attachments. Transmits entire body weight to the calcaneus. Talar neck fractures may disrupt blood supply causing avascular necrosis in up to 50 percent.



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## Tangier Disease

An autosomal-recessive disorder of HDL metabolism caused by ABCA1 dysfunction. It produces very low HDL cholesterol, enlarged yellow-orange tonsils, hepatosplenomegaly, peripheral neuropathy, thrombocytopenia, and premature atherosclerosis in some patients.

## Tanner Staging

A scale for assessing sexual maturity during puberty. Stage 1: prepubertal. Stage 2: breast buds (girls), testicular enlargement (boys). Stage 3: breast enlargement, pubic hair. Stage 4: areolar development, more pubic hair.

## Thelarche

The onset of breast development, usually the first visible sign of female puberty. It commonly begins between ages 8 and 13, with substantial normal variation.

## Tapeworm

A parasitic flatworm with a segmented body that may live in the intestine or form larval cysts in tissues. People acquire different species by eating infected meat or fish or by ingesting eggs from contaminated sources. Symptoms and complications depend on the species and site.

## Tapeworm Infection

Infection caused by parasitic tapeworms. *Taenia* species may live as adult worms in the intestine, while some tapeworm larvae can form cysts in tissues.

## Tardive Dyskinesia

Involuntary, repetitive, purposeless movements caused by prolonged use of antipsychotic medications, typically developing after months to years of exposure. Movements include choreoathetoid movements of the tongue, face, and extremities (lip smacking, tongue protrusion, grimacing, choreiform movements of limbs).

## Target-Controlled Infusion

A computerized infusion pump system that main-

tains a predetermined drug concentration in plasma or effect site using pharmacokinetic modeling. TCI systems use three-compartment pharmacokinetic models to calculate infusion rates that achieve and maintain target concentration.

## Targeted Temperature Management

Controlled therapeutic hypothermia for comatose survivors of cardiac arrest. Target: 32-36 degrees C for 24-72 hours followed by gradual rewarming. Mechanism: reduces metabolic demand, limits reperfusion injury, and reduces free radical generation. TTM2 trial showed 33 degrees C was not superior to 36 degrees C.

## Targeted Therapy

Drugs targeting specific molecular abnormalities in cancer. Examples: imatinib (BCR-ABL), trastuzumab (HER2), rituximab (CD20), tyrosine kinase inhibitors. Requires molecular testing.

## Tarlov Cyst

A cerebrospinal-fluid-filled perineural cyst, usually located near the dorsal root ganglia in the sacral spine. Many are incidental, but larger or symptomatic cysts can cause sacral pain, radiculopathy, sensory change, bowel or bladder dysfunction, or sexual dysfunction.

## Tarsal Coalition

An abnormal connection between two bones in the rear or middle foot, usually present from birth. It can cause a stiff, painful flatfoot, recurrent ankle sprains, and limited foot motion, often becoming more noticeable during adolescence.

## Tarsal Tunnel Syndrome

Tibial nerve compression at ankle. Symptoms: burning pain, tingling in foot sole. Tinel sign at ankle. Treatment: orthotics, corticosteroid injection, surgical decompression.

## Taste

The sensation produced by the interaction of chemical substances with taste receptor cells (TRCs) on the tongue, palate, pharynx, epiglottis, and upper

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esophagus. Taste is one of the five primary senses (gustation).

### **Tau PET**

Tracers: Flortaucipir, MK-6240. Detect tau tangles in neurodegenerative diseases.

### **Taurodontism**

Enlarged pulp chamber, short roots. Molars most affected. Associated with genetic conditions.

### **Tay-Sachs Disease**

Autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder (HEXA gene, hexosaminidase A). Accumulation of GM2 ganglioside in neurons. Ashkenazi Jewish prevalence higher. Symptoms: developmental regression, cherry-red spot on macula, seizures, paralysis, death by age 4. No cure.

### **TCA Cycle**

The tricarboxylic acid (Krebs) cycle occurs in the mitochondrial matrix, completing the oxidation of acetyl-CoA (from carbohydrates, fats, and proteins) to CO<sub>2</sub> while generating reducing equivalents (NADH, FADH<sub>2</sub>) for the electron transport chain.

### **TCAs**

Tricyclic antidepressants are a class of drugs that inhibit the reuptake of serotonin and norepinephrine, similar to SNRIs, but also block histamine H<sub>1</sub> receptors, muscarinic acetylcholine receptors, and alpha-1 adrenergic receptors, producing numerous side effects.

### **TCAs (Tricyclic Antidepressants)**

Antidepressants that block reuptake of serotonin and norepinephrine, with additional anticholinergic, antihistaminic, and alpha-adrenergic blocking effects. Examples include amitriptyline, nortriptyline, imipramine, and desipramine. They are effective for depression, neuropathic pain, and migraine prophylaxis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Tricyclic Antidepressants

### **Tdap Vaccination In Pregnancy**

Administration of tetanus, diphtheria, and acellular pertussis (Tdap) vaccine during each pregnancy, optimally at 27-36 weeks. The goal: boost maternal antibodies to protect the newborn from pertussis (whooping cough) before the infant can be vaccinated at 2 months.

### **Tdap Vaccine**

Tetanus, Diphtheria, and acellular Pertussis booster given at 11-12 years and during each pregnancy (27-36 weeks gestation). Replaces one dose of Td. Important for pertussis protection, particularly for protecting newborns through maternal antibody transfer. Also given to adolescents and adults to maintain tetanus and diphtheria immunity.

### **Technetium-99M**

Most widely used radionuclide in nuclear medicine. Half-life: 6 hours. Emits 140 keV gamma rays. Produced from molybdenum-99/technetium-99m generator. Used with various ligands: MDP (bone), sestamibi (myocardium), DTPA (renal), nanocolloid (lymphatic), HMPAO (brain perfusion).

### **Technique**

The method, equipment, and protocol used to perform a medical examination, procedure, or imaging study.

### **Tedizolid Pharmacokinetics**

The study of how tedizolid is absorbed, distributed, metabolized, and eliminated. Tedizolid is available orally and intravenously and has pharmacokinetic properties that support once-daily treatment; its clinical use depends on the infection and patient factors.

### **Teenage Pregnancy**

Pregnancy in adolescents (usually 10-19 years), associated with higher maternal and fetal risks: preterm birth, low birth weight, preeclampsia, anemia, and increased neonatal mortality; also socioeconomic and educational consequences. Causes: unprotected intercourse, lack of contraception/education, poverty, and peer/family factors.

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## Teeth

Hard, mineralized structures in the mouth used for cutting, tearing, and grinding food.

## Teething

Teething is eruption of an infant's primary teeth through the gums and may cause gum discomfort, drooling, and chewing; high fever or severe illness suggests another cause.

## Tele Radiology

Remote interpretation of imaging studies.

## Tele-Rehabilitation

Remote rehabilitation via technology. Video consultations, remote monitoring, home exercise programs. Increases access, especially rural.

## Telemedicine

Remote delivery of healthcare using technology. Examples: video visits, remote monitoring, store-and-forward. Increases access.

## Telogen Effluvium

Diffuse hair shedding caused by premature entry of hair follicles into the telogen (resting) phase. Triggers include severe illness, surgery, childbirth, rapid weight loss, emotional stress, medications (beta-blockers, retinoids, anticoagulants), and nutritional deficiencies (iron, zinc, vitamin D).

## Telomere

Protective DNA sequence at chromosome ends. Shortens with cell division. Associated with aging.

## Temperature

A measurement of body heat. The result varies with the measurement site, time, activity, age, and illness.

## Temperature (Body Temperature)

The balance between heat production (metabolism, muscle activity) and heat loss (radiation, conduction, convection, evaporation). Normal core body temperature: 36.5–37.5°C (97.7–99.5°F), regulated

by the hypothalamus (preoptic anterior hypothalamus—thermoregulatory center).

### Synonyms:

Body Temperature

## Temple Syndrome

A genomic-imprinting disorder involving chromosome 14q32 that causes prenatal and postnatal growth restriction, hypotonia, developmental delay, feeding difficulty, short stature, and abnormal pubertal development.

## Temporal Arteritis

A vasculitic disorder affecting medium and large arteries, particularly the temporal artery, predominantly occurring in adults over 50 years of age.

## Temporal Bones

Paired bones forming the cranial floor and lateral wall, with squamous, petrous, mastoid, tympanic, and styloid parts. Contain the external auditory canal, middle and inner ear, and foramina: carotid canal (internal carotid), jugular foramen (CN IX–XI, IJV), and foramen lacerum.

## Temporal Lobe

One of the four major lobes of the cerebral hemisphere, located beneath the lateral fissure (Sylvian fissure) on the lateral surface of the brain, extending medially to the parahippocampal gyrus. The temporal lobe is involved in auditory processing, language comprehension, memory, and emotion.

## Temporal Lobe Epilepsy

The most common form of focal (partial) epilepsy, arising from the medial temporal lobe structures (hippocampus, amygdala, parahippocampal gyrus).

## Temporomandibular Joint

Synovial ginglymoarthrodial joint between mandibular condyle and temporal bone's mandibular fossa, separated by an articular disc. Only bilateral body joint, allowing hinge and sliding movements. Disc divides into superior/inferior compartments. Temporomandibular disorders cause pain, clicking, limited movement, common with bruxism.

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## Temporomandibular Joint Disorder

Pain and dysfunction of TMJ and masticatory muscles. Symptoms: jaw pain, clicking, limited opening, headache, ear pain. Etiology: multifactorial (bruxism, stress, trauma, occlusion). Treatment: conservative (reassurance, self-care, splint, NSAIDs), physical therapy, rare surgery.

## Temporomandibular Joint Replacement

Total joint replacement for severe TMJ pathology. Indications: ankylosis, severe degenerative disease, failed previous surgery.

## Temporomandibular Joint Syndrome

Pain or dysfunction involving the jaw joint and chewing muscles, often causing jaw pain, clicking, restricted opening, headache, or tooth-related symptoms. Causes include clenching, trauma, arthritis, and stress-related muscle tension. Persistent locking, severe pain, or inability to eat requires dental or medical evaluation.

## Tendinitis

Tendinitis is painful inflammation or degeneration of a tendon, often from repetitive loading, causing localized tenderness and pain with movement.

## Tendon

Dense regular connective tissue connecting muscle to bone, composed primarily of type I collagen fibers arranged in parallel bundles. Transmits muscle force to bone to produce movement. Poor vascularity (slower healing). Enclosed in tendon sheath (synovial) at friction points.

## Tendon Transfer

Surgical relocation of a functioning tendon to restore movement or balance when the original muscle-tendon unit is absent, paralyzed, or irreparable. Successful transfer requires an adequate donor, appropriate excursion, and a stable recipient joint.

## Tendonitis

Tendinopathy: inflammation or degeneration of a tendon from overuse, repetitive strain, or trauma, causing localized pain, swelling, and tenderness with

activity. Common sites: rotator cuff (supraspinatus), lateral elbow (tennis elbow), medial elbow (golfer's elbow), Achilles, patellar (jumper's knee), biceps, and De Quervain.

## Tenecteplase

A modified tissue plasminogen activator (TNK-tPA) thrombolytic with longer half-life, higher fibrin specificity, and resistance to PAI-1. Used for acute ischemic stroke and STEMI. Given as a single IV bolus (weight-based), simplifying administration. Adverse effects: hemorrhage (intracranial—major concern), allergic reactions.

## Tenesmus

A distressing sensation of needing to empty the bowel or bladder despite little output, commonly caused by rectal inflammation, infection, tumor, constipation, or urinary irritation.

## Tennis Elbow

Lateral epicondylitis, a tendinopathy of the common extensor tendon at the lateral epicondyle (extensor carpi radialis brevis). Caused by repetitive wrist extension and overuse, not limited to tennis. Presents with lateral elbow pain worsened by wrist extension and grip. Tenderness over the lateral epicondyle.

### Synonyms:

Epicondylitis, Lateral Elbow Tendinopathy, Lateral Epicondylitis, Lateral Epicondylosis

## Tenosynovitis

Tenosynovitis is inflammation of the sheath surrounding a tendon, producing pain, swelling, and restricted gliding, commonly in the hand or wrist.

## Tension Headache

The most common headache type, characterized by bilateral, pressing/tightening head pain of mild-moderate intensity (like a band around the head), lasting 30 min to days, without nausea or vomiting; photophobia or phonophobia may be present but not both.

## Tension Pneumothorax

Life-threatening pneumothorax with mediastinal

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shift. Emergency needle decompression (2nd intercostal space, midclavicular line) followed by chest tube. Signs: respiratory distress, hypotension, tracheal deviation, distended neck veins, unilateral absent breath sounds.

### **Teratogen**

Substance causing birth defects. Examples: thalidomide, isotretinoin, alcohol, warfarin, valproate, ACE inhibitors. Prenatal exposure critical.

### **Teratogenicity**

The ability of a drug, chemical, or infectious agent to cause birth defects or developmental abnormalities when exposure occurs during pregnancy. The risk of teratogenic effects depends on the timing of exposure, with the embryonic period from 3 to 8 weeks after fertilization being the most critical for organogenesis.

### **Teratoma**

A type of germ cell tumor composed of tissues derived from two or three germ layers (ectoderm, endoderm, mesoderm), reflecting pluripotent differentiation.

### **Terbinafine**

An allylamine antifungal agent that inhibits squalene epoxidase, an early enzyme in the ergosterol biosynthesis pathway, causing accumulation of squalene and depletion of ergosterol in the fungal cell membrane. The accumulation of squalene is fungicidal, while ergosterol depletion disrupts membrane function.

### **Teriparatide For Osteoporosis**

Recombinant human parathyroid hormone fragments one through thirty-four that stimulate osteoblast-mediated bone formation. Indicated for severe osteoporosis with fractures or very low T-scores and for patients who have failed or are intolerant to bisphosphonates. Daily subcutaneous injection for up to two years.

### **Terminal Delirium**

Delirium occurring near the end of life, often

caused by advanced organ failure, medication effects, metabolic disturbance, infection, or reduced cerebral perfusion. Management prioritizes comfort, reversible contributors when consistent with goals, and support for the patient and family.

### **Terminal Illness**

An advanced disease that is expected to lead to death, although the timing and response to available treatment may vary.

### **Tertiary Prevention**

Reducing complications from established disease. Examples: rehabilitation, chronic disease management, palliative care.

### **Test Strips**

Reagents for diagnostic testing. Types: urine dipstick, blood glucose, ketone.

### **Testicular Cancer**

Most common solid malignancy in young men 15-35 years. Types: germ cell tumors (seminoma, non-seminoma), sex cord-stromal tumors. Presentation: painless testicular mass, heaviness, ache. Diagnosis: scrotal ultrasound, tumor markers (AFP, beta-hCG, LDH).

#### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Testicular

### **Testicular Disorders**

Conditions affecting the testes or surrounding structures, including torsion, infection, inflammation, trauma, tumors, and hormonal disorders. Symptoms may include pain, swelling, a mass, infertility, or changes in sexual development and require appropriate evaluation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Infection Testicle (Testicular Disorders) Pain Scrotum (Testicular Disorders) Torsion Testicle (Testicular Disorders) Tumor Testicle (Testicular Disorders)

### **Testicular Microlithiasis**

Multiple tiny calcifications within the testicular tissue seen on ultrasound. The finding alone does not



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establish cancer, and follow-up depends on other risk factors and clinical findings.

### **Testicular Torsion**

Surgical emergency caused by twisting of the spermatic cord around its longitudinal axis, cutting off venous return and leading to arterial occlusion, ischemia, and infarction of the testicle.

#### **Synonyms:**

Torsion, Testicular

### **Testicular Torsion Emergency**

Rotation of the spermatic cord that compromises testicular blood flow, causing sudden unilateral scrotal pain, nausea, a high-riding testis, and an abnormal cremasteric reflex. Immediate surgical exploration and detorsion are required; imaging must not delay treatment when suspicion is high.

### **Testis**

The male reproductive gland that produces spermatozoa in seminiferous tubules and secretes testosterone from interstitial Leydig cells. It is normally located in the scrotum.

### **Testis (Testicle)**

The male gonad, a paired ovoid organ (4–5 cm × 2–3 cm, weight 15–20 g) located in the scrotum, responsible for sperm production (spermatogenesis) and testosterone secretion. Each testis is covered by the tunica vaginalis (peritoneal remnant) and tunica albuginea (dense fibrous capsule).

#### **Synonyms:**

Testicle

### **Testosterone**

Testosterone examines testosterone; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. essential for the development of male reproductive tissues, secondary sexual characteristics, and overall health.

### **Tetanus**

Tetanus is toxin-mediated neurologic disease caused

by *Clostridium tetani* entering a wound, producing painful muscle rigidity, spasms, autonomic instability, and respiratory failure. introduced through wounds. Characterized by generalized rigidity and painful muscle spasms (trismus/lockjaw, risus sardonicus, opisthotonos). Autonomic instability can occur in severe cases. Diagnosis: clinical.

#### **Synonyms:**

Lockjaw

### **Tetany**

A clinical syndrome of neuromuscular hyperexcitability caused by hypocalcaemia (most common—total calcium <2.1 mmol/L, ionised calcium <1.1 mmol/L), but also caused by hypomagnesaemia, hypokalaemia, and alkalosis (respiratory or metabolic).

### **Tethered Cord Syndrome**

A congenital or acquired condition where the spinal cord is abnormally attached (tethered) to surrounding tissues, restricting its normal upward movement within the spinal canal. Caused by a thickened filum terminale, lipomeningomyelocele, diastematomyelia, or previous myelomeningocele repair.

### **Tetracycline Stain**

Intrinsic discoloration from tetracycline antibiotics during tooth development. Gray or brown bands. Treatment: bleaching, veneers, crowns.

### **Tetracyclines**

A class of bacteriostatic antibiotics that bind reversibly to the 30S ribosomal subunit and block the attachment of aminoacyl-tRNA to the acceptor site, inhibiting protein synthesis. They include tetracycline, doxycycline, and minocycline.

### **Tetralogy Of Fallot**

Tetralogy of Fallot is a congenital heart defect combining ventricular septal defect, right-ventricular outflow obstruction, overriding aorta, and right-ventricular hypertrophy.

### **Th1/Th2/Th17/Tfh/Treg Balance**

CD4+ T helper subsets defined by master tran-



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scription factors and signature cytokines: Th1 (T-bet, IFN-gamma, IL-12, STAT4): intracellular pathogens, autoimmunity (RA, MS, type 1 diabetes). Th2 (GATA3, IL-4/5/13, IL-4/STAT6): helminths, allergy, asthma.

### Thalamus

Bilateral ovoid gray matter structure forming the third ventricle's lateral walls, the brain's relay station for nearly all sensory (except olfaction), motor, and limbic information to the cortex. Numerous nuclei: VPL (spinothalamic, dorsal column), VPM (trigeminal), LGN (visual), MGN (auditory), VL/VA (motor).

### Thalassemia

A group of inherited hemoglobin disorders caused by reduced or absent synthesis of one or more globin chains, leading to microcytic hypochromic anemia.

#### Synonyms:

Cooley's Anemia Mediterranean Anemia

### Thalassemia Major

Beta-thalassemia, an autosomal recessive hemoglobin disorder with absent or minimal beta-globin chain production. Presents in infancy with severe anemia, failure to thrive, hepatosplenomegaly, and skeletal deformities. Diagnosis by hemoglobin electrophoresis showing absent HbA and elevated HbF and HbA2.

### Thallium Scan

Nuclear medicine imaging using Tl-201. Myocardial perfusion, tumor detection. Largely replaced by Tc-99m agents.

### Thallium-201

SPECT radionuclide, half-life 73 hours. Used for myocardial perfusion imaging. Mechanism: K<sup>+</sup> analog, taken up by Na<sup>+</sup>/K<sup>+</sup> ATPase.

### Thanatology

The scientific study of death, dying, postmortem changes, and the psychological, social, and ethical aspects of bereavement. In forensic medicine, it also examines the circumstances and evidence surround-

ing death.

### Thanatophoric Dysplasia

A severe skeletal dysplasia, usually caused by an FGFR3 variant, with markedly shortened limbs, narrow thorax, macrocephaly, and characteristic skull and vertebral abnormalities. The severe thoracic restriction commonly causes neonatal respiratory failure.

### Theranostic Pair

Combined therapy and diagnostics using matched radiopharmaceutical pairs. See theranostics.

### Theranostics

Combined therapy and diagnostics using matched radiopharmaceutical pairs. Diagnostic isotope (e.g., Ga-68) identifies target, therapeutic isotope (e.g., Lu-177) delivers treatment. Examples: Ga-68/Lu-177 DOTATATE (neuroendocrine tumors), PSMA theranostics (prostate cancer).

### Therapeutic Alliance

The collaborative, trusting relationship between therapist and patient that is foundational to effective psychotherapy. It includes agreement on goals, tasks, and the bond between therapist and patient. It is the strongest predictor of psychotherapy outcome across all therapeutic modalities.

### Therapeutic Drug Monitoring

The clinical practice of measuring specific drug concentrations in blood or plasma to individualize drug dosing and ensure therapeutic effectiveness while minimizing toxicity. TDM is particularly important for drugs with narrow therapeutic indices, where small changes in concentration can lead to therapeutic failure or toxicity.

### Therapeutic Exercise

Exercise prescribed to improve function, reduce pain, prevent disability. Types: stretching, strengthening, aerobic, balance, functional. Progression: low to high intensity.

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## Therapeutic Hypothermia

Controlled cooling of the body temperature used in psychiatric practice for severe catatonia and neuroleptic malignant syndrome. In NMS, cooling is a key treatment alongside discontinuation of the offending agent and dantrolene administration.

## Therapeutic Index

The therapeutic index is a quantitative measure of the relative safety of a drug, defined as the ratio of the dose that produces toxicity in 50 percent of the population to the dose that produces the desired therapeutic effect in 50 percent of the population.

## Therapeutic Window

The range of plasma drug concentrations between the minimum effective concentration (producing a therapeutic effect) and the minimum toxic concentration (producing toxicity), in which efficacy is achieved with acceptable toxicity.

## Therapeutics

The branch of medicine concerned with the treatment of disease, encompassing all interventions used to prevent, manage, or cure illness.

## Therapy

Treatment intended to prevent, relieve, or cure disease or to improve function and quality of life.

## Therapy Monitoring

Repeated clinical assessment, laboratory testing, or imaging used to evaluate response, adverse effects, and ongoing need for treatment.

## Thermal Injury

Tissue damage caused by heat, flame, hot liquid, steam, or cold. Burn severity depends on depth, total body surface area, location, inhalation injury, associated trauma, and patient factors; assessment should include airway and circulatory complications.

## Thermal Injury (Burns)

Tissue damage caused by heat. Initial care includes stopping the exposure, removing loose constricting

material, cooling briefly with clean water, covering the injury, and assessing depth and extent. Larger or deeper burns require specialized evaluation, fluid management, pain control, wound care, and tetanus assessment.

### Synonyms:

Burns

## Thermal Therapy

Treatment using heat or cold to influence pain, swelling, muscle tension, or tissue temperature. Effects and safety depend on the condition and method used.

## Thermogenesis

Heat production from food digestion, muscle activity, brown fat. Diet-induced thermogenesis 10% of TDEE.

## Thermometer

Device measuring body temperature. Types: mercury (phased out), digital, tympanic, temporal artery, infrared. Normal oral: 36.5-37.5°C.

## Thermoneutral Zone

The range of ambient temperatures over which body temperature is maintained by basal metabolic heat production alone, without additional thermoregulatory responses such as shivering or sweating. In humans the zone is approximately 27-32 degrees C for a resting nude adult. Within the zone, vasomotor tone adjusts heat loss.

## Thermoplasty

A bronchoscopic procedure that uses radiofrequency energy to ablate smooth muscle in the airways, reducing bronchospasm. It is approved for severe, persistent asthma in adults not controlled with ICS/LABA. It reduces exacerbations and emergency department visits but does not improve lung function.

## Thermoregulation

The physiological maintenance of core body temperature near the set point ( 37 degrees C) via a balance of heat production and heat loss, controlled

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by the preoptic area of the hypothalamus.

### **Thiamine**

Vitamin B1, a water-soluble vitamin required for carbohydrate metabolism and nerve function. Severe deficiency can cause beriberi or Wernicke encephalopathy.

### **Thiamine (Vitamin B1)**

A water-soluble vitamin whose active coenzyme form, thiamine pyrophosphate, is required by pyruvate dehydrogenase, alpha-ketoglutarate dehydrogenase, transketolase, and branched-chain ketoacid dehydrogenase. Deficiency causes beriberi and Wernicke encephalopathy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vitamin B1

### **Thiazide Diuretics**

Thiazide diuretics act on the distal convoluted tubule by inhibiting the sodium-chloride cotransporter, reducing sodium and chloride reabsorption and producing natriuresis and diuresis. They are less potent than loop diuretics but have a longer duration of action, typically 6 to 12 hours.

### **Thiazolidinediones**

Insulin sensitizers activating peroxisome proliferator-activated receptors primarily in adipose tissue and skeletal muscle. Agents include pioglitazone and rosiglitazone. Mechanisms include enhanced insulin-mediated glucose uptake, altered adipokine secretion, and reduced hepatic glucose output.

### **Thiopental Sodium**

An ultra-short-acting barbiturate, used for induction of general anesthesia (IV, onset 30–60 seconds, duration 5–10 minutes) and as a third-line agent for raised intracranial pressure (cerebroprotective effect: reduces cerebral metabolism, cerebral blood flow, and intracranial pressure).

### **Third Stage Of Labor**

From delivery of the baby to delivery of the placenta. The placenta separates from the uterine wall and is expelled spontaneously or with gentle cord traction.

Normal duration: 5-30 minutes.

### **Third Trimester**

The period from 28 weeks to delivery. Rapid fetal weight gain occurs, lungs mature with surfactant production. Fetal movements become regular and countable. Braxton Hicks contractions begin. Group B Streptococcus screening at 36 weeks.

### **Third-Degree AV Block**

Complete heart block with no conduction between atria and ventricles. Atria and ventricles beat independently (AV dissociation). Ventricular escape rhythm: junctional (40-60, narrow QRS) or ventricular (20-40, wide QRS).

### **Third-Degree Burn**

A full-thickness burn that destroys the epidermis and dermis and may extend into subcutaneous tissue. The skin may appear white, brown, or charred and sensation may be reduced. Assessment includes burn depth, extent, inhalation injury, and associated trauma; deep or extensive burns require specialist treatment and may need grafting.

### **Thoracentesis**

A medical term referring to thoracentesis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Thoracic Aortic Aneurysm**

Aneurysm of thoracic aorta. Associated with hypertension, Marfan syndrome, bicuspid aortic valve.

### **Thoracic Cage**

The bony and cartilaginous framework formed by the thoracic vertebrae, ribs, costal cartilages, and sternum. It protects thoracic organs and assists respiratory movements.

### **Thoracic Cavity**

The chest cavity, enclosed by the ribs and chest muscles, containing the lungs, heart, esophagus, and trachea.

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## Thoracic Duct

Body's largest lymphatic vessel, approximately 40 cm long, draining lymph from the entire body below the diaphragm and left side above it (approximately 75 percent of total lymph).

## Thoracic Endometriosis

Endometrial tissue within the thoracic cavity causing catamenial pneumothorax, hemothorax, or lung nodules, recurring cyclically with menstruation and often requiring hormonal suppression.

## Thoracic Outlet Syndrome

Compression of neurovascular bundle at thoracic outlet. Types: neurogenic (most common), venous, arterial. Symptoms: neck/shoulder/arm pain, paresthesia, weakness, vascular symptoms. Diagnosis: clinical, imaging, nerve conduction. Treatment: physical therapy, surgical decompression.

### Synonyms:

TOS (Thoracic Outlet Syndrome)

## Thoracic Vertebrae

Have costal facets on bodies and transverse processes for rib articulation. Heart-shaped bodies, long downward spinous processes, coronally-oriented facets allowing rotation and lateral flexion but limiting flexion/extension. Small circular vertebral foramen.

## Thoracolumbar Spine Trauma

Injury to the thoracic or lumbar spine. Assessment includes fracture morphology, posterior ligamentous complex integrity, and neurologic status. Classification systems such as AO Spine and TLICS help guide management, which depends on stability and the clinical context.

## Thoracotomy

A surgical incision into the chest wall to access the thoracic cavity (pleural space, lungs, heart, great vessels, esophagus, diaphragm, mediastinum).

## Thought Blocking

An abrupt interruption in the train of thought before

it is completed, as if the thought was removed or pushed out of the patient's mind. The patient may pause mid-sentence, appear confused, and report that the thought was "taken out" or "blocked." It is a formal thought disorder seen in schizophrenia.

## Threadworm (Enterobiasis)

An intestinal parasitic infection caused by *Enterobius vermicularis*, also called pinworm. Infection spreads when eggs are swallowed, often after contact with contaminated hands, bedding, food, or surfaces.

### Synonyms:

Enterobiasis

## Three-Dimensional Ultrasound

Ultrasound creating 3D images. Used in obstetrics, gynecology.

## Throat Cancer

Cancer arising in the pharynx or nearby structures of the throat. Persistent hoarseness, difficulty or pain with swallowing, a neck lump, unexplained weight loss, or persistent sore throat requires medical evaluation, especially in people who use tobacco or alcohol.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Throat

## Thrombectomy

A surgical or interventional radiology procedure to remove a blood clot (thrombus) from a blood vessel, restoring blood flow. Types: (1) Endovascular thrombectomy (mechanical thrombectomy)—for acute ischemic stroke due to large vessel occlusion (LVO—internal carotid artery, middle cerebral artery M1 segment).

## Thrombectomy (Vascular)

Removal of a blood clot from a blood vessel, using an open surgical or catheter-based procedure.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Thromboangiitis Obliterans (Buerger

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## **Disease)**

An inflammatory disease of small and medium blood vessels, strongly associated with tobacco use. It can cause pain, color changes, ulcers, or gangrene in the hands or feet. Complete tobacco cessation is essential; further treatment depends on ischemia, tissue loss, and other complications.

### **Synonyms:**

Buerger Disease

## **Thrombocytes**

Small, anucleate, disc-shaped cell fragments (2–4  $\mu\text{m}$  diameter) derived from megakaryocytes in the bone marrow, circulating at  $150\text{--}400 \times 10^9/\text{L}$ . See Platelets (Thrombocytes).

## **Thrombocytopathy**

A disorder of platelet function that impairs primary hemostasis despite a normal or near-normal platelet count. It may be inherited or acquired and can cause mucocutaneous bleeding, easy bruising, prolonged bleeding after procedures, or menorrhagia.

## **Thrombocytopenia**

Thrombocytopenia is a low platelet count caused by reduced production, increased destruction or consumption, sequestration, or dilution and may increase bleeding risk.

### **Synonyms:**

Low Platelet Count

## **Thrombocytosis**

An elevated platelet count ( $>450,000/\mu\text{L}$ ). Reactive (secondary): infection, inflammation, iron deficiency, malignancy, post-splenectomy, hemorrhage, exercise—usually mild, no thrombotic risk.

## **Thromboelastography**

A viscoelastic whole-blood assay that measures the initiation, formation, strength, and breakdown of a clot. It provides a functional overview of coagulation and fibrinolysis and may guide targeted blood-component therapy in major bleeding.

## **Thromboembolism**

Obstruction of a blood vessel by a clot that formed elsewhere and traveled through the circulation.

## **Thrombolysis**

The dissolution of a blood clot using a medicine such as a fibrinolytic agent. It is used only in selected conditions because it can cause serious bleeding.

## **Thrombolysis For PE**

Systemic thrombolytics (alteplase) for massive PE with hemodynamic instability. Rapid clot dissolution but significant bleeding risk.

## **Thrombolysis For Stroke**

Thrombolysis with intravenous alteplase (tPA) is the primary acute treatment for ischemic stroke when administered within the time window of symptom onset. Alteplase is a recombinant tissue plasminogen activator that converts plasminogen to plasmin, which degrades fibrin in the thrombus, restoring blood flow to the ischemic brain.

## **Thrombolytic**

A drug that dissolves blood clots by activating plasminogen to plasmin, which degrades fibrin. Agents: alteplase (tPA), tenecteplase (TNK-tPA), reteplase, streptokinase, urokinase. Indications: acute ischemic stroke (within 4.5 hours), STEMI, massive pulmonary embolism, and acute limb ischemia.

## **Thrombophilia**

A tendency to develop venous thromboembolism (VTE) due to inherited or acquired hypercoagulable states. Inherited: factor V Leiden, prothrombin G20210A mutation, antithrombin deficiency, protein C deficiency, protein S deficiency.

## **Thrombophilia Testing**

Thrombophilia testing evaluates for inherited and acquired hypercoagulable states in patients with venous thromboembolism, recurrent pregnancy loss, or strong family history of VTE.



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## Thrombophlebitis

Thrombophlebitis is inflammation of a vein associated with a blood clot and may be superficial or involve deep veins with risk of pulmonary embolism.

## Thrombopoiesis

The production of platelets from megakaryocytes in the bone marrow. It is regulated principally by thrombopoietin and involves megakaryocyte maturation, proplatelet formation, and release of circulating platelets.

## Thrombosed Intracranial Aneurysm

An intracranial arterial aneurysm that has undergone partial or complete thrombosis of its lumen, which may reduce rupture risk but can cause mass effect on adjacent brain structures. Presents with headache, cranial nerve palsies, or seizures depending on location. Diagnosis: CT, MRI, or conventional angiography.

## Thrombosis

The formation of a blood clot within the cardiovascular system during life, potentially obstructing blood flow and causing tissue ischemia or infarction. Arterial thrombi typically form on ruptured atherosclerotic plaques, are composed primarily of platelets and fibrin, and appear pale and grossly attached to the vessel wall.

## Thrombosis Of The Inferior Vena Cava

Formation of a blood clot within the inferior vena cava, which may occur in the setting of IVC filters, malignancy, hypercoagulable states, or extension from iliofemoral deep vein thrombosis. May cause bilateral lower extremity edema, abdominal pain, and hepatic or renal dysfunction. Requires anticoagulation and possible thrombectomy.

## Thrombotic Microangiopathy

Endothelial damage with platelet-rich microthrombi causing MAHA with schistocytes, thrombocytopenia, and organ ischemia. TTP from ADAMTS13 deficiency treated with plasmapheresis. HUS from Shiga toxin managed supportively. Atypical HUS from complement dysregulation responds to

eculizumab.

## Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura

A life-threatening thrombotic microangiopathy usually caused by acquired or inherited deficiency of ADAMTS13, the enzyme that cleaves large von Willebrand factor multimers. It causes platelet consumption, red-cell fragmentation, and possible organ ischemia.

## Thrombotic Vasculopathy

A spectrum of disorders characterized by thrombus formation within blood vessels of various sizes, often associated with antiphospholipid syndrome, disseminated intravascular coagulation, thrombotic thrombocytopenic purpura, or malignancy.

## Thrombus Organization

The process by which a thrombus is gradually replaced by granulation tissue and eventually fibrous scar tissue. The process begins when inflammatory cells, particularly macrophages, infiltrate the thrombus and begin digesting the fibrin and dead cells through fibrinolysis.

## Thrush

A common vaginal infection caused by the yeast *Candida albicans* (also called candidiasis, vaginal thrush, or candida vulvovaginitis). Symptoms: itching, soreness, white discharge (like cottage cheese), dyspareunia, and external dysuria. Risk factors: pregnancy, antibiotic use, diabetes, immunosuppression, and high estrogen states.

### Synonyms:

candidiasis, vaginal thrush, or candida vulvovaginitis). Yeast Oral (Thrush)

## Thumb CMC Arthritis

Thumb carpometacarpal (CMC) arthritis: Eaton-Littler classification: I (normal), II (slight narrowing, osteophytes <2mm), III (narrowing, osteophytes >2mm, subluxation), IV (pantrapezial arthritis). Clinical: base of thumb pain, pinch weakness, thenar wasting, squaring (subluxation).



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## Thymoma

A tumor of thymic epithelial cells, associated with myasthenia gravis, pure red cell aplasia, and hypogammaglobulinemia. Malignant behavior is determined by capsular invasion and stage.

### Synonyms:

Neoplasm Thymomic (Thymoma)

## Thymus

Primary lymphoid organ in the anterior mediastinum, largest in childhood, involutes with age. Site of T-cell maturation (thymopoiesis): thymocytes undergo positive and negative selection to produce self-tolerant, MHC-restricted T cells. Epithelial cells produce thymic hormones (thymosin, thymopoietin).

## Thyroglobulin Surveillance

Thyroglobulin produced only by thyroid follicular cells serves as a tumor marker after total thyroidectomy for differentiated thyroid carcinoma. In patients who have undergone complete thyroidectomy and radioactive iodine ablation thyroglobulin should be undetectable.

## Thyroglossal Duct Cyst

Congenital midline neck mass resulting from persistence of the thyroglossal duct the embryological tract of thyroid descent. Most common congenital neck mass presenting in childhood. Located at or near the hyoid bone and moves with swallowing and tongue protrusion. Diagnosis is by ultrasound demonstrating a cystic midline neck mass.

## Thyroid Cancer

A malignant tumor of the thyroid. Major types include papillary, follicular, medullary, and anaplastic carcinoma, which differ in behavior and treatment.

### Synonyms:

Cancer, Thyroid

## Thyroid Cancer Staging

American Joint Committee on Cancer TNM staging for differentiated thyroid carcinoma incorporates tumor size, extent of invasion, lymph node metastases, and distant metastases. Age is a critical prognos-

tic factor with patients under fifty having more favorable outcomes. Stage I is any tumor without metastases in patients under fifty.

## Thyroid Cartilage

The largest cartilage of the larynx, formed by two plates that meet in front and create the laryngeal prominence. It protects the vocal folds and provides attachment for muscles and ligaments.

## Thyroid Disorders

Conditions affecting the thyroid gland, a butterfly-shaped endocrine organ in the neck that produces hormones regulating metabolism, growth, and development.

## Thyroid Eye Disease

Autoimmune inflammatory disorder of the orbital tissues associated with Graves disease characterized by expansion of extraocular muscles and orbital fat. Pathogenesis involves orbital fibroblasts expressing the TSH receptor targeted by the same thyroid-stimulating immunoglobulins affecting the thyroid.

## Thyroid Fine-Needle Aspiration

Image-guided sampling of thyroid-nodule cells for cytologic classification. Results are commonly reported using the Bethesda system and guide surveillance, molecular testing, surgery, or other management.

## Thyroid Follicular Carcinoma

approximately 10 to 15 percent of thyroid cancers and is the second most common differentiated thyroid malignancy. Unlike papillary carcinoma, follicular carcinoma typically spreads hematogenously to distant sites including bone, lung, and liver, rather than to regional lymph nodes.

## Thyroid Function Tests

Laboratory assessment of the hypothalamic-pituitary-thyroid axis. TSH is the most sensitive screening test with elevated levels indicating primary hypothyroidism and suppressed levels indicating hyperthyroidism. Free T4 measures the biologically active unbound thyroxine.

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## Thyroid Gland

An endocrine gland located in the anterior neck, consisting of two lobes (right and left) connected by an isthmus, lying anterior to the trachea between the cricoid cartilage and the suprasternal notch.

## Thyroid Hormone

T3 and T4. Increase basal metabolic rate. Required for normal development.

## Thyroid Nodule

A discrete lump within the thyroid gland that may be solid, cystic, benign, or malignant. Most are benign, but evaluation uses clinical assessment, thyroid testing, ultrasound, and biopsy when indicated.

## Thyroid Nodule Evaluation

Systematic approach to evaluation of thyroid nodules detected by physical examination or imaging. Thyroid ultrasound characterizes nodule features including size, composition, echogenicity, margins, calcifications, and shape. TI-RADS classification stratifies malignancy risk and guides biopsy decisions.

## Thyroid Papillary Carcinoma

The most common differentiated thyroid cancer, arising from thyroid follicular cells. It often grows slowly and has a favorable prognosis, although outcome depends on tumor features, spread, age, and response to treatment.

## Thyroid Peroxidase Antibody

An autoantibody against thyroid peroxidase, an enzyme required for thyroid-hormone synthesis. It supports autoimmune thyroid disease, especially Hashimoto thyroiditis, but may be present in some euthyroid individuals.

## Thyroid Scan

Nuclear medicine imaging using I-123 or Tc-99m. Evaluates thyroid function and nodules. Hot nodules rarely malignant. Cold nodules require further evaluation.

## Thyroid Scintigraphy

Thyroid imaging using I-123, I-131, or Tc-99m pertechnetate. Assesses function, nodules, ectopic tissue. Hot nodules (functioning) rarely malignant; cold nodules require ultrasound/FNA.

## Thyroid Stimulating Hormone

TSH (thyrotropin): the anterior pituitary hormone that stimulates the thyroid to produce and release T4 and T3, controlled by TRH (hypothalamus) and negative feedback from thyroid hormones.

## Thyroid Storm

Life-threatening exacerbation of thyrotoxicosis presenting with hyperpyrexia, tachycardia, heart failure, altered mental status, and multi-organ dysfunction. Precipitated by infection, surgery, trauma, or iodine load in patients with untreated hyperthyroidism. Mortality rates range from twenty to thirty percent.

## Thyroid Surgery

Operations that remove part or all of the thyroid gland. They may be performed for selected cancers, enlarging or compressive nodules, goiter, hyperthyroidism, or diagnostic uncertainty; the procedure depends on the disease and its extent.

## Thyroid Ultrasound

High-frequency sonographic imaging used to evaluate thyroid size, nodules, cysts, cervical lymph nodes, and structural features associated with malignancy. Suspicious nodules may require ultrasound-guided fine-needle aspiration.

## Thyroiditis

Inflammation of the thyroid gland with various etiologies. Hashimoto thyroiditis: autoimmune, most common cause of hypothyroidism in iodine-sufficient areas. Subacute (De Quervain) thyroiditis: post-viral, presents with painful thyroid and transient hyperthyroidism followed by hypothyroidism.

## Thyroiditis Classification

Inflammatory conditions of the thyroid classified by clinical presentation and etiology. Hashimoto thy-

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roiditis is chronic autoimmune with hypothyroidism. Graves disease is autoimmune with hyperthyroidism. Subacute thyroiditis is painful and likely viral.

### **Thyrotoxic Periodic Paralysis**

Recurrent episodes of transient flaccid weakness associated with thyrotoxicosis, usually accompanied by hypokalemia caused by intracellular potassium shift. Attacks often affect the proximal limbs and are triggered by rest after exercise or carbohydrate-rich meals.

### **TI-RADS**

The Thyroid Imaging Reporting and Data System is an ultrasound-based system that assigns a risk category to thyroid nodules using features such as composition, echogenicity, shape, margins, and calcification. It helps guide follow-up and biopsy decisions.

### **Tibia**

The tibia is the larger medial bone of the lower leg, extending from the knee to the ankle; it bears much of the body's weight and forms parts of both joints. Proximal: tibial plateau (medial/lateral condyles) and tibial tuberosity (patellar ligament insertion). Shaft: sharp subcutaneous anterior border. Distal: medial malleolus articulating with the talus at the ankle.

### **Tibial Nerve**

Sciatic division (L4-S3) continuing from posterior thigh through the popliteal fossa into the deep posterior leg, innervating gastrocnemius, soleus, tibialis posterior, flexor digitorum longus, and flexor hallucis longus. Passes behind the medial malleolus as the tarsal tunnel, dividing into medial/lateral plantar nerves for the foot.

### **Tibial Shaft Fractures**

Tibial shaft fractures: most common long bone fracture. AO/OTA: 42-A (simple), 42-B (wedge), 42-C (complex). Soft tissue critical: Gustilo for open.

### **Tibialis Anterior Muscle**

Superficial anterior leg muscle from lateral tibial condyle and shaft to medial cuneiform and first metatarsal base. Innervated by deep peroneal nerve (L4-L5). Primary dorsiflexor for foot clearance during gait swing phase; inverts foot. Weakness causes foot drop with steppage gait.

### **Tibialis Posterior Muscle**

Deepest posterior leg muscle from posterior tibia, fibula, and interosseous membrane to navicular tuberosity, medial cuneiform, and sustentaculum tali. Innervated by tibial nerve (L4-L5). Plantarflexes and inverts foot; primary dynamic medial longitudinal arch stabilizer.

### **Tic Douloureux**

A chronic pain condition characterized by recurrent, sudden, severe, electric shock-like pain in the distribution of the trigeminal nerve (typically V2/V3). See Trigeminal Neuralgia.

### **Tick Paralysis**

Acute, progressive flaccid paralysis caused by neurotoxin released by an attached tick. Weakness usually begins in the legs and ascends; respiratory failure can occur and symptoms improve after prompt tick removal.

### **Tickborne Relapsing Fever**

A vector-borne illness caused by *Borrelia hermsii* and related species, transmitted by *Ornithodoros* ticks. It presents with recurrent episodes of fever, headache, myalgia, and arthralgia, separated by afebrile intervals. The relapsing pattern results from antigenic variation of the spirochete's surface lipoproteins.

### **Tics**

Sudden, rapid, recurrent, nonrhythmic stereotyped movements (motor tics) or vocalizations (vocal tics) that are usually brief and suppressible. Transient tics (most common in childhood) vs. chronic tic disorder; Tourette syndrome: multiple motor + at least one vocal tic for >1 year beginning before age 18.

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## Tidal Volume

The volume of air inspired or expired during each normal breath, approximately 500 mL (6-8 mL/kg) in a resting adult. Tidal volume is measured by spirometry. Minute ventilation = tidal volume x respiratory rate ( 6 L/min). Only a portion reaches the alveoli (alveolar ventilation) after subtracting dead space ( 150 mL).

## Tilt Table Test

Evaluation of unexplained syncope by reproducing orthostatic stress. Patient is strapped to a motorized table tilted from supine to 60-80 degrees for 20-45 minutes. Positive: reproduction of symptoms with hypotension and/or bradycardia (vasovagal syncope, delayed orthostatic hypotension).

## Tilt Table Testing

A supervised test in which a patient is moved from a lying to an upright or head-up tilt position while blood pressure, heart rate, and symptoms are monitored. It may help evaluate reflex syncope, orthostatic hypotension, or selected autonomic disorders when the diagnosis remains uncertain; it does not replace assessment for cardiac or neurologic causes.

## Time In Range

Percentage of time that continuous glucose monitoring readings remain within the target glucose range of seventy to one hundred eighty milligrams per deciliter for most adults with diabetes. General target is greater than seventy percent corresponding to approximately seventeen hours per day.

## Time Of Death

The moment or estimated time at which biological death occurred, a key medicolegal question. Estimated from postmortem changes: body cooling (algor mortis), rigor mortis, lividity (livor mortis), decomposition/putrefaction, insect colonization, and chemical changes (vitreal potassium, vitreal glucose, body temperature).

## Time-Of-Flight PET

A PET acquisition and reconstruction technique that uses the measured arrival-time difference of

coincident annihilation photons to improve localization of the annihilation event. It can improve signal-to-noise performance, especially in larger patients.

## Timed Up-And-Go Test

A functional mobility test measuring the time required to stand from a chair, walk a short distance, turn, return, and sit. Prolonged performance suggests impaired mobility and increased fall risk but must be interpreted with gait, vision, cognition, and environment.

## Timothy Syndrome

A rare multisystem disorder caused by pathogenic variants in CACNA1C, characterized by marked QT prolongation and congenital heart disease with syndactyly. Developmental, neurological, immune, and facial features may also occur.

## Tincture

Alcohol extract of plant or chemical substance. Common concentration: 10-40% alcohol. Examples: tincture of iodine (antiseptic), tincture of benzoin (skin protector). Also used for liquid medications.

## Tinea

Dermatophytosis: superficial fungal infection of keratinized tissue (skin, hair, nails) by dermatophytes (Trichophyton, Microsporum, Epidermophyton).

## Tinea (Dermatophytosis)

Superficial fungal infection by dermatophytes. Tinea corporis (ringworm): annular, scaly, erythematous plaque with central clearing. Tinea pedis (athlete's foot): interdigital scaling, maceration, and fissuring. Tinea cruris (jock itch): erythematous, pruritic rash in groin with raised border.

### Synonyms:

Dermatophytosis

## Tinea Barbae

Dermatophyte infection of the beard and mustache area, presenting with erythematous, scaly, follicular papulopustules or deep inflammatory nodules, often acquired from contact with infected animals or

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through grooming. It may be inflammatory (kerion-like) or superficial, and differential diagnosis includes bacterial folliculitis and acne.

### **Tinea Capitis**

A dermatophyte infection of the scalp and hair shafts, most common in children. It may cause scaling, alopecia, broken hairs, black dots, or an inflammatory kerion.

### **Tinea Circinata**

An older term for tinea corporis (ringworm) of the body, presenting as annular, erythematous, scaly plaques with active, raised borders and central clearing. It is caused by dermatophyte fungi and may be acquired through direct contact with infected humans, animals, or fomites.

### **Tinea Corporis**

A dermatophyte infection of glabrous skin, presenting as annular, erythematous, scaly plaques with raised, active borders and central clearing. It is contagious through direct contact with infected persons, animals, or contaminated objects. Diagnosis is by KOH preparation showing branching septate hyphae.

### **Tinea Faciei**

Dermatophyte infection of the facial skin, often presenting with erythematous, scaly, annular or ill-defined plaques that may mimic eczema or rosacea, leading to frequent misdiagnosis. It is commonly caused by *Trichophyton* or *Microsporum* species and may be acquired from pets, other humans, or self-inoculation from other body sites.

### **Tinea Imbricata**

A chronic dermatophyte infection caused by *Trichophyton concentricum*, endemic in the South Pacific and Southeast Asia, characterised by widespread, concentric, overlapping, polycyclic scaly rings producing a "wood-grain" pattern on the trunk and limbs.

### **Tinea Incognito**

A dermatophyte infection whose clinical appearance

has been altered by inappropriate topical corticosteroid or immunosuppressive treatment. It may become less scaly and more extensive or atypical; fungal testing is often needed before directed therapy.

### **Tinea Nigra**

A superficial fungal infection of the stratum corneum caused by *Hortaea werneckii*, presenting as a painless, brown to black, non-scaly macule or patch, most commonly on the palms or soles. It is acquired in tropical and subtropical regions and is often confused with acral melanoma.

### **Tinea Pedis**

A dermatophyte infection of the feet presenting in interdigital, moccasin, vesicobullous, or ulcerative patterns. It may coexist with tinea unguium. Diagnosis is clinical or mycologic when uncertain; treatment uses topical antifungals for limited disease and oral therapy for extensive, refractory, or nail-associated infection.

### **Tinea Versicolor**

A superficial fungal infection caused by *Malassezia* species, presenting as hypo- or hyperpigmented macules with fine scale on the trunk and proximal extremities. It is more noticeable after sun exposure due to unaffected tanning of surrounding skin.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pityriasis Versicolor

### **Tinel Sign**

Tapping over nerve produces tingling in distribution. Indicates nerve irritation/regeneration. Used for carpal tunnel, cubital tunnel, tarsal tunnel.

### **Tinnitus**

Tinnitus is perception of sound without an external source, often related to hearing loss, noise exposure, ear disease, medications, vascular causes, or neurologic factors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ringling In The Ear



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## Tiotropium Bromide

A long-acting muscarinic antagonist (LAMA) bronchodilator used for maintenance therapy in COPD. Once-daily dosing provides sustained bronchodilation. It reduces exacerbations and improves lung function. It is often combined with a LABA for additive bronchodilation.

## TIPS (Transjugular Intrahepatic Portosystemic Shunt)

A radiologically placed shunt connecting the portal vein to a hepatic vein within the liver, creating a portosystemic shunt to reduce portal pressure. Indications: variceal bleeding (refractory or recurrent), refractory ascites, and hepatic hydrothorax.

### Synonyms:

Transjugular Intrahepatic Portosystemic Shunt

## Tissue

A group of similar cells and their surrounding materials that work together to perform a specific function.

## Tissue Distribution

Reversible movement of a chemical from blood into tissues and organs. Distribution is influenced by perfusion, lipid solubility, protein binding, tissue affinity, barriers, body composition, and time after exposure.

## Tissue Expander

Balloon implanted under skin/muscle, gradually filled with saline to expand tissue. Used for breast reconstruction, scalp reconstruction, burn coverage. Removed after expansion, replaced with permanent implant or flap.

## Tissue Fixation

Preservation of tissue morphology and molecular components by chemical or physical methods before processing. Neutral buffered formalin is commonly used for routine histopathology, while fixation choice affects antigen detection, nucleic-acid testing, and tissue architecture.

## Tissue Plasminogen Activator-Associated

## Angioedema

Angioedema occurring as a complication of tissue plasminogen activator therapy for acute ischemic stroke or myocardial infarction, affecting approximately 1 to 5 percent of patients. It typically involves the face, tongue, and upper airway and may be life-threatening.

## Titanium

Biocompatible metal for implants and frameworks. Osseointegration capability.

## Titer

Titer examines titer; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. expressed as the highest dilution that still produces a detectable reaction (e.g., 1:128).

## TLC

Thin-layer chromatography for radiochemical purity.

## TNF Alpha

Tumor necrosis factor alpha is a potent pro-inflammatory cytokine produced primarily by activated macrophages, as well as by T cells, NK cells, mast cells, and endothelial cells. TNF-alpha exists as a 26-kilodalton transmembrane protein that is cleaved by the metalloprotease TACE to release a soluble 17-kilodalton active form.

## TNM Staging

A cancer-staging system describing the primary tumor, regional lymph nodes, and distant metastases to estimate disease extent and prognosis.

## Tocolysis

The use of medication to delay preterm birth for a limited time, often to allow corticosteroid treatment or transfer to a facility with appropriate neonatal care. The drug, gestational-age range, and contraindications depend on local guidance and the clinical situation.



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## **Tocolytic Therapy**

Medications used to inhibit uterine contractions temporarily to prolong pregnancy, allowing time for corticosteroid administration and transport to a tertiary care center. Indications: preterm labor with intact membranes, 24-34 weeks.

## **Tocolytics**

Medications used to suppress preterm labor (contractions before 37 weeks gestation), to delay delivery for corticosteroid administration (fetal lung maturity) and in utero transport to a tertiary care center.

## **Toe Pressure**

Pressure in toe digits. Useful when ankle pressures non-compressible (diabetes, renal disease).

## **Toe-Brachial Index**

The ratio of systolic toe pressure to brachial systolic pressure. It can support diagnosis of peripheral arterial disease when ankle arteries are noncompressible because of medial arterial calcification.

## **Toll-Like Receptor**

A class of single-pass membrane-spanning pattern recognition receptors (PRRs) expressed on innate immune cells (macrophages, dendritic cells). Recognize evolutionary conserved microbial structures (PAMPs).

## **Tonic Neck Reflex**

A primitive reflex present from birth to 6 months, also called fencer's pose. When the head is turned to one side, the arm on that side extends while the opposite arm flexes. Present in both directions. Asymmetry may indicate neurologic injury. Disappears as voluntary head control develops.

### **Synonyms:**

fencer's pose.

## **Tonic-Clonic Seizure**

A generalized seizure with a tonic stiffening phase followed by rhythmic clonic jerking, impaired consciousness, and a postictal state.

## **Tonsillar Cancer**

A malignancy arising from the palatine tonsils, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma associated with HPV infection. It often presents with throat pain, otalgia, and cervical lymphadenopathy.

## **Tonsillectomy**

Tonsillectomy examines tonsillectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. apnea, or other selected conditions after assessment of potential benefits and risks.

## **Tonsils**

Aggregated lymphoid tissue forming Waldeyer's ring at the pharyngeal entrance. Pharyngeal tonsils (adenoids) in the nasopharynx, palatine tonsils at the oropharyngeal pillars, lingual tonsils at the tongue base, and tubal tonsils near the Eustachian tube orifices. They are the first line of defense against inhaled or ingested pathogens.

## **Tooth Eruption**

Process by which tooth moves from intraosseous position to functional occlusion. Primary (deciduous) dentition: 20 teeth, eruption 6-30 months. Permanent dentition: 32 teeth (including third molars), eruption 6-21 years. Delayed eruption may indicate systemic conditions, local obstruction, or normal variant.

## **Tooth Infection**

Infection of the tooth, its pulp, or surrounding tissues, commonly caused by untreated decay, cracks, or gum disease. It may cause toothache, sensitivity, swelling, fever, or drainage. Facial swelling, difficulty swallowing or breathing, or spreading infection requires emergency assessment.

## **Tooth Luxation**

Traumatic displacement of a tooth without complete avulsion. Concussion and subluxation involve periodontal injury with little or no displacement, whereas extrusive, lateral, and intrusive luxation involve increasingly marked displacement and require prompt dental evaluation.

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## **Tooth Replantation**

Replacement of an accidentally displaced or avulsed tooth into its socket, followed by stabilization and dental follow-up.

## **Tooth Sensibility Testing**

Clinical testing of a tooth's response to thermal, electric, or dentin stimulation. It assesses neural response rather than directly measuring pulp blood flow, so results must be interpreted with history, examination, and imaging.

## **Tooth Sensitivity**

Pain in response to thermal, sweet, acidic, or tactile stimulus. Caused by dentin exposure (recession, erosion, abrasion, abfraction). Management: desensitizing toothpaste, fluoride varnish, restorative coverage, gum graft for recession.

## **Tophaceous Gout**

Chronic tophaceous gout represents advanced gout with deposition of large, visible tophi consisting of monosodium urate crystals surrounded by granulomatous inflammation. Tophi typically develop after years of inadequately treated gout and occur on the ears, fingers, toes, and olecranon bursa.

## **Topical Antibiotics**

Antibiotics applied to the skin to treat selected superficial bacterial infections. The choice and duration depend on the organism, site, extent of infection, resistance patterns, and local guidance. Unnecessary or prolonged use can cause irritation and antimicrobial resistance.

## **Topical Antifungals**

Topical antifungals treat superficial fungal infections. Allylamines (terbinafine, naftifine) inhibit squalene epoxidase, fungicidal. Azoles (clotrimazole, miconazole, ketoconazole, econazole) inhibit ergosterol synthesis, fungistatic. Ciclopirox has broad-spectrum activity. Tolnaftate is effective against dermatophytes.

## **Topical Calcineurin Inhibitors**

Non-steroidal anti-inflammatory agents used for

atopic dermatitis and facial eczema. They inhibit T-cell activation by blocking calcineurin, preventing cytokine production. Advantages over corticosteroids: no skin atrophy, safe for face and intertriginous areas. Side effects include transient burning and itching at application site.

## **Topical Corticosteroid Potency**

Topical corticosteroids are classified into seven potency groups. Group 1 (ultra-high): clobetasol propionate 0.05 percent. Group 2 (high): betamethasone dipropionate 0.05 percent. Group 3 to 4 (medium): triamcinolone acetonide 0.1 percent. Group 5 to 6 (low): hydrocortisone 1 percent.

## **Topical Retinoids**

Vitamin A derivatives used for acne, photoaging, and hyperpigmentation. Tretinoin (all-trans retinoic acid) is the most studied. Adapalene is more stable and less irritating. Tazarotene is the most potent. Mechanism: normalizes follicular keratinization, increases cell turnover, and stimulates collagen production.

## **TORCH Panel**

Serologic screening for congenital infections: Toxoplasma, Rubella, CMV, Herpes simplex (and others: syphilis, parvovirus B19, VZV, Zika). IgM: indicates recent/active infection (maternal or fetal). IgG: past infection or passive immunity. Paired maternal and neonatal testing.

## **Torsades De Pointes**

A specific form of polymorphic ventricular tachycardia with QRS complexes that twist around the baseline, occurring in the setting of QT prolongation. It may degenerate to ventricular fibrillation.

## **Torticollis (Wryneck)**

A condition in which the head is tilted to one side (ear toward the shoulder) and rotated to the opposite side (chin toward opposite shoulder), due to contraction or shortening of the sternocleidomastoid muscle.

### **Synonyms:**

Wryneck

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### **Torus Mandibularis**

A bony outgrowth arising from the lingual surface of the mandible, typically bilateral and located in the premolar region above the mylohyoid ridge. It is a common, asymptomatic developmental anomaly, more prevalent in women and certain ethnic populations.

### **Torus Palatinus**

A bony exostosis arising from the midline of the hard palate, typically presenting as a slow-growing, asymptomatic, hard, bony protuberance discovered incidentally. It is more common in women and certain ethnic groups.

### **Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Return**

A congenital heart defect in which the pulmonary veins drain into the systemic venous circulation instead of the left atrium. The clinical effects depend on the anatomic type, the degree of obstruction, and associated defects; affected newborns require specialist cardiac evaluation.

### **Total Body Surface Area**

The percentage of body surface involved by a burn or other extensive skin process. It is estimated using methods such as the rule of nines, Lund-Browder chart, or the patient's palm and is used to guide burn severity assessment and resuscitation.

### **Total Breech Extraction**

A maneuver where the operator grasps the fetal feet and delivers the entire baby in breech presentation. The most common indication is delivery of the second twin (malpresentation). Contraindicated for term singleton breech due to high risk of head entrapment, nuchal arms, and birth trauma.

### **Total Daily Energy Expenditure**

Total calories burned in 24 hours: BMR + thermic effect of food + physical activity. Estimation guides dietary recommendations. Activity factor multiplies BMR.

### **Total Haemolytic Complement Test**

A functional assay of the classical complement pathway, commonly reported as CH50.

### **Total Hip Arthroplasty**

Replacement of the hip joint with prosthetic components. Acetabular component: metal shell + polyethylene liner. Femoral component: metal stem + femoral head (cobalt-chrome or ceramic). Fixation: cemented (PMMA, for elderly, osteoporotic bone), cementless (porous-coated, for younger patients, biologic fixation), and hybrid.

### **Total Intravenous Anesthesia**

Total intravenous anesthesia (TIVA) uses intravenous agents exclusively for induction and maintenance of anesthesia, avoiding volatile inhalation agents. The most common TIVA regimen combines propofol infusion (50 to 200 mcg/kg/min) with remifentanyl infusion (0.1 to 0.5 mcg/kg/min).

### **Total Iron Binding Capacity**

TIBC: a measure of the maximum iron-binding capacity of transferrin in serum, reflecting total iron-transport capacity. Calculated from transferrin or measured directly.

### **Total Knee Arthroplasty**

Replacement of the knee joint with prosthetic components. Femoral component (cobalt-chrome), tibial component (titanium tray + polyethylene insert), and patellar component (polyethylene, optional). Fixation: cement (PMMA) most common in older adults; cementless in younger.

### **Total Lesion Glycolysis**

Product of metabolic tumor volume and mean SUV. Prognostic marker.

### **Total Lung Capacity**

The total volume of air in the lungs after maximal inspiration. It is measured by lung-volume testing, such as body plethysmography, and may be increased in hyperinflation or decreased in restrictive lung disease.

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## Total Parenteral Nutrition

Intravenous administration of nutrients sufficient to meet essentially all nutritional requirements when the gastrointestinal tract cannot be used adequately.

## Tourette Disorder

A neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by multiple motor tics and one or more vocal tics lasting >1 year, with onset before age 18. Motor tics: eye blinking, head jerking, shoulder shrugging, facial grimacing. Vocal tics: throat clearing, sniffing, grunting, barking, coprolalia (obscene words, occurs in <10%).

## Tourette Syndrome

A neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by multiple motor tics and at least one vocal tic occurring over at least one year. Tics are sudden, rapid, recurrent, stereotyped movements or vocalizations. They are often preceded by premonitory urges. Tics typically worsen in adolescence and may improve in adulthood.

### Synonyms:

Tourette's

## Townes Syndrome

A congenital disorder caused by pathogenic variants in *SALL1*, classically involving anal atresia and characteristic thumb abnormalities. Renal, cardiac, hearing, foot, and genital anomalies are common and variable.

## Toxic Dose

Dose causing toxicity. Varies by substance, individual, route, duration.

## Toxic Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction caused by exposure to a toxic substance or medicine. Symptoms may include confusion, altered behavior, seizures, or reduced consciousness.

## Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis

A severe, potentially fatal mucocutaneous reaction, usually to a medication, causing extensive epidermal

necrosis and skin detachment. It is on the severe end of the Stevens–Johnson syndrome and toxic epidermal necrolysis spectrum and requires urgent specialist care.

### Synonyms:

TEN

## Toxic Megacolon

Acute life-threatening dilation of the colon associated with systemic toxicity, representing one of the most serious complications of inflammatory bowel disease, particularly ulcerative colitis. It can also occur in infectious colitis caused by *Clostridioides difficile* and cytomegalovirus.

## Toxicokinetics

The study of absorption, distribution, metabolism, and excretion of a toxic substance and its relationship to concentration over time. Toxicokinetics helps estimate exposure, timing, accumulation, and expected duration of toxicity.

## Toxicology Specimen Preservation

Collection, labeling, storage, and transport of biological specimens to preserve analytes and prevent contamination or degradation. Appropriate specimens may include peripheral blood, urine, vitreous humor, bile, liver, hair, or gastric contents depending on the suspected exposure and timing.

## Toxidrome

A recognizable pattern of signs and symptoms produced by a class of toxins. Important patterns include opioid, sympathomimetic, anticholinergic, cholinergic, sedative-hypnotic, and serotonin toxidromes; treatment combines supportive care, targeted antidotes when available, and decontamination decisions.

## Toxoid Vaccines

Vaccines that protect against harmful bacterial toxins. These vaccines contain toxins that have been detoxified and rendered inactive.

## Toxoplasma Gondii

An obligate intracellular protozoan parasite that

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causes toxoplasmosis. The definitive host is the cat (family Felidae), which sheds environmentally resistant oocysts in feces.

### **TPMT Polymorphism**

Thiopurine S-methyltransferase is an enzyme that metabolizes thiopurine drugs including azathioprine, 6-mercaptopurine, and thioguanine, which are used in the treatment of leukemia, inflammatory bowel disease, and autoimmune conditions.

### **Trabeculectomy**

A conventional glaucoma filtration surgery that creates a new drainage pathway for aqueous humor by removing a small piece of the trabecular meshwork and creating a partial-thickness scleral flap under which aqueous humor filters from the anterior chamber into the subconjunctival space, forming a filtering bleb.

### **Tracer Principle**

Administered in amounts too small to produce pharmacological effect. Dose optimized for imaging, not therapeutic.

### **Tracheal Agenesis With Bronchoesophageal Fistula**

Congenital malformation characterized by absent or severely hypoplastic trachea with an abnormal communication between the bronchus and esophagus, a rare and typically fatal condition presenting in neonates with respiratory distress, cyanosis, and inability to intubate.

### **Tracheal Foreign Body**

A foreign object lodged in the trachea, causing severe respiratory distress, stridor, and complete airway obstruction. It is a medical emergency requiring immediate bronchoscopic removal. In complete obstruction, emergency cricothyrotomy may be needed.

### **Tracheal Stenosis**

Narrowing of the trachea, often a complication of prolonged endotracheal intubation or tracheostomy. It presents with progressive dyspnea, stridor, and

wheezing that may be mistaken for asthma. Diagnosis is by bronchoscopy or CT. Treatment is balloon dilation, stenting, or surgical resection.

### **Tracheobronchomalacia**

Abnormal softening of the trachea and/or bronchi causing excessive airway collapse during breathing. It may be congenital or acquired. Symptoms include chronic cough, recurrent infections, and expiratory airflow obstruction. Diagnosis is by dynamic CT or bronchoscopy. Treatment includes CPAP, stenting, or surgical reconstruction.

### **Tracheobronchomegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of the trachea and main bronchi, usually associated with connective-tissue weakness. It may cause recurrent lower-respiratory infection, bronchiectasis, ineffective cough, dyspnea, and difficulty clearing airway secretions.

### **Tracheoesophageal Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the trachea and esophagus, often associated with esophageal atresia. Presents with recurrent aspiration, coughing with feedings, and cyanosis during meals. The H-type fistula may present later in infancy with chronic aspiration and failure to thrive. Diagnosis by esophagram or bronchoscopy.

### **Tracheomalacia**

Softening of the tracheal cartilage causing excessive collapse of the trachea during expiration. It may be congenital or acquired (prolonged intubation, relapsing polychondritis). Symptoms include expiratory stridor and difficulty clearing secretions. Diagnosis is by dynamic CT or bronchoscopy.

### **Tracheostomy Tube**

A tube inserted through a tracheostomy opening to maintain access to the airway and permit breathing, suction, or mechanical ventilation.

### **Tracheotomy**

An operation that creates an opening through the neck into the trachea. The opening is called a tracheostomy.



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### **Tractional Retinal Detachment**

Separation of the neurosensory retina caused by contraction of fibrovascular membranes, commonly associated with proliferative diabetic retinopathy.

### **Train-Of-Four Monitoring**

Train-of-four monitoring assesses neuromuscular blockade by delivering four supramaximal electrical stimuli at 2 Hz to a peripheral nerve, commonly the ulnar nerve at the wrist. The ratio of the fourth twitch height to the first twitch height estimates recovery from non-depolarizing blockade.

### **Trained Immunity**

Innate immune memory: epigenetic/metabolic reprogramming of monocytes/macrophages/NK cells after initial stimulus (BCG, beta-glucan, Candida, oxidized LDL) -> enhanced response to secondary challenge (heterologous protection).

### **Trajectory**

The path a projectile follows in flight and, in wound ballistics, the course it traverses through tissue from entrance to exit or rest. Internal trajectory is reconstructed from entrance and exit defects, the organ track, recovered fragments, and clothing damage; angles disclose shooter position and victim posture.

### **TRALI**

Transfusion-Related Acute Lung Injury, a life-threatening complication of blood transfusion characterized by acute hypoxemia and bilateral pulmonary edema within 6 hours of transfusion, without evidence of volume overload.

### **Tram-Track Appearance**

Histological finding on silver stain of MPGN representing GBM duplication. Results from mesangial cell interposition into capillary wall with new basement membrane formation. Creates double-contour pattern on Jones methenamine silver stain.

### **Trans Fat**

A type of unsaturated fat with at least one trans double bond. Industrial trans fats are associated with increased cardiovascular risk and have been

restricted in many jurisdictions.

### **Transabdominal Scan**

An ultrasound scan performed with the transducer placed on the maternal abdomen. A full bladder improves visualization of pelvic structures. Used in early pregnancy to confirm viability and gestational age, and throughout pregnancy to assess fetal growth, anatomy, amniotic fluid volume, and placental location.

### **Transarterial Chemoembolization**

A procedure in which chemotherapy and embolizing particles are infused selectively into tumor-feeding hepatic arteries, combining regional chemotherapy with ischemic tumor necrosis; used for unresectable hepatocellular carcinoma.

### **Transbronchial Biopsy**

Bronchoscopic biopsy of lung parenchyma obtained through the bronchial wall. It is used to diagnose interstitial lung diseases (sarcoidosis, HP), reject lung transplant rejection, and sample peripheral lung lesions. It carries a higher risk of pneumothorax than endobronchial biopsy.

### **Transcervical Foley Catheter For Cervical Ripening**

A mechanical method for cervical ripening: a Foley catheter (16-30 Fr) is inserted through the cervix, the balloon is inflated with 30-60 mL of saline, and traction is applied (or the catheter is taped to the thigh with gentle tension). The balloon applies direct pressure to the internal os, stimulating endogenous prostaglandin release.

### **Transcranial Doppler**

Ultrasound measuring blood flow velocity in cerebral arteries. Used for vasospasm detection, stroke risk assessment.

### **Transcription**

Synthesis of RNA from DNA template by RNA polymerase. Eukaryotic: RNA Pol II transcribes mRNA, rRNA, snRNA; RNA Pol I transcribes rRNA; RNA Pol III transcribes tRNA, 5S rRNA. Steps: initia-



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tion (promoter recognition, transcription factors), elongation (5' to 3'), termination. Promoter elements: TATA box, CAAT box, GC box.

### **Transcription Factor**

Protein binding to specific DNA sequences, regulating transcription. Activators enhance transcription; repressors inhibit. Examples: p53, NF-kB, steroid hormone receptors.

### **Transdermal**

A route of drug administration delivering drug through intact skin into the systemic circulation via a patch or gel, bypassing first-pass metabolism and providing steady plasma concentrations over hours to days. Examples: nitroglycerin, fentanyl, nicotine, estrogen, clonidine, rotigotine.

### **Transfer Training**

Teaching safe transfer techniques: bed to chair, chair to toilet, floor to standing. Use of transfer boards, lift equipment.

### **Transferase**

An enzyme that transfers a functional group from one molecule to another.

### **Transference**

A psychoanalytic concept in which feelings, attitudes, and expectations originally directed toward a significant figure from childhood are unconsciously redirected onto the therapist. In psychodynamic therapy, transference is a therapeutic tool for understanding the patient's relational patterns and resolving conflicts.

### **Transferrin**

An iron transport protein synthesized by the liver, carrying iron in plasma (2 iron-binding sites). In iron deficiency: transferrin is elevated with low ferritin, giving high TIBC and low transferrin saturation; in iron overload/inflammation/chronic disease: transferrin is low (acute phase).

### **Transfusion Medicine**

Blood components: PRBCs (leukoreduced, irradiated for at-risk), FFP (coagulation factors), platelets (apheresis pooled, leukoreduced), cryoprecipitate (fibrinogen, vWF, factor VIII, XIII). ABO/Rh compatibility.

### **Transfusion Of Neonate**

Administration of a blood product to a newborn for clinically significant anemia, bleeding, or another specific indication. The decision, product characteristics, volume, and rate depend on the infant's symptoms, laboratory results, gestational age, and local transfusion protocol.

### **Transfusion Reaction**

An adverse reaction to transfusion of blood products. Acute hemolytic transfusion reaction: ABO incompatibility, immediate fever/chills, hypotension, back pain, DIC, renal failure; management: STOP transfusion, maintain BP/urine output, supportive care.

### **Transient Ischemic Attack**

A transient ischemic attack (TIA) is a temporary episode of neurological dysfunction caused by focal brain, spinal cord, or retinal ischemia without acute infarction.

### **Transient Tachypnea Of The Newborn**

Temporary rapid breathing after birth, usually caused by delayed clearance of fetal lung fluid. It is more common after caesarean birth and typically improves within one to three days with supportive care.

### **Transition To Adulthood**

Support for youth with disabilities transitioning to adult services.

### **Transitional Care**

Coordinated care provided when a person moves between healthcare settings or levels of care, such as from hospital to home.

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## Translation

Decoding of mRNA sequence into polypeptide chain by ribosomes. Occurs in cytoplasm. tRNAs carry specific amino acids and recognize codons via anti-codons. Steps: initiation, elongation, termination. Energy: GTP hydrolysis.

## Transplacental

Passing through or occurring across the placenta.

## Transplant Immunology

Hyperacute rejection: preformed anti-donor antibodies (ABO, HLA) -> immediate graft failure (minutes-hours); prevented by crossmatch.

## Transplant Rejection

Immune-mediated destruction of a transplanted organ or tissue, classified by timing and mechanism. Hyperacute: preformed donor-specific antibodies, minutes to hours post-transplant, immediate graft thrombosis, irreversible; prevention by cross-matching.

## Transplant Surgery

Transplant surgery involves replacing a failing organ with a healthy donor organ. Kidney transplant: living donors (laparoscopic nephrectomy, left kidney preferred) or deceased donors (standard criteria, expanded criteria, DCD).

## Transport

Regulations for shipping radioactive materials. Package types: excepted, A, B.

## Transposition Of The Great Arteries

A congenital heart defect in which the aorta arises from the right ventricle and the pulmonary artery from the left ventricle. This creates parallel circulations, so survival after birth depends on adequate mixing through an associated opening or ductus until definitive treatment is provided.

### Synonyms:

Transposition Of Great Vessels

## Transposons

Mobile genetic elements that can move between different locations within the bacterial genome or between the chromosome and plasmids. Transposons carry genes including antibiotic resistance genes and can facilitate the spread of resistance.

## Transudate

A transudate is a type of edema fluid with low protein content and few cells, resulting from imbalances in hydrostatic and oncotic pressures across capillary walls rather than from inflammation or increased vascular permeability.

## Transudative Pleural Effusion

From systemic factors altering hydrostatic/oncotic pressures. Most commonly from heart failure. Low protein, low LDH. Treatment addresses the underlying cause.

## Transurethral Resection Of The Prostate

An endoscopic operation that removes obstructing prostate tissue to improve urine flow in selected people with benign prostatic enlargement. Alternatives and indications depend on symptoms, prostate size, complications, and patient preference.

## Transverse Colon

Longest, most mobile colonic segment from hepatic to splenic flexure, approximately 45 cm, with complete mesentery (transverse mesocolon). Crosses anterior to duodenum, pancreas, and major vessels. Splenic flexure is the highest colon point and common gas trapping site. Most common diverticular disease site along with the sigmoid.

## Transverse Lie

A fetal lie where the long axis of the fetus is perpendicular to the long axis of the mother. The presenting part is a shoulder or arm. Occurs in approximately 1% of term pregnancies. Risk of cord prolapse and obstructed labor. Cesarean delivery required as vaginal delivery is not possible.

## Transverse Myelitis

An inflammatory disorder of the spinal cord causing

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acute or subacute motor, sensory, and autonomic dysfunction.

### **Transverse Plane**

A horizontal plane that divides the body or an organ into upper (superior) and lower (inferior) portions.

### **Transversus Abdominis Muscle**

Deepest flat abdominal muscle with horizontal fibers, from inguinal ligament, iliac crest, thoracolumbar fascia, and inner lower six costal cartilages. Innervated by T7-T12 and L1. Compresses abdomen without trunk movement, providing core stability and increased intra-abdominal pressure during coughing, lifting, Valsalva.

### **Transvestic Disorder**

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent sexual arousal from cross-dressing that causes marked distress, impairment, or harm, or is acted on without consent. It is distinct from gender dysphoria, which concerns gender identity rather than sexual arousal.

### **TRAP Sequence**

Twin Reversed Arterial Perfusion sequence, a complication of monochorionic twin gestations where one twin (the pump twin) perfuses the other (the acardiac twin) via arterioarterial anastomoses.

### **Trapezius Muscle**

Large triangular muscle from occipital bone and C7-T12 spinous processes to clavicle, acromion, and scapular spine. Innervated by CN XI and C3-C4. Upper fibers elevate scapula, middle fibers retract, lower fibers depress. Essential for shoulder stability and scapulothoracic motion.

### **Trapezoid**

Smallest distal row carpal bone between trapezium and capitate, articulating with the second metacarpal. Wedge shape provides stability for the firmly fixed second metacarpal. Fractures rare (less than 1 percent of carpal fractures). Contributes to the radial column wrist stability.

### **Trauma (Vascular)**

Injury to a blood vessel caused by blunt force, penetrating injury, fracture, medical procedures, or other mechanisms.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vascular

### **Trauma Center**

Hospital designated to provide comprehensive care for injured patients. Levels: Level I (complete care, research, prevention), Level II (similar but limited resources), Level III (stabilization, transfer), Level IV (advanced trauma life support, transfer). Transfer criteria: need for higher level of care, specific injuries.

### **Trauma Surgery**

Trauma surgery encompasses the acute care of injured patients, guided by ATLS (ABCDE) principles: Airway maintenance with cervical spine protection, Breathing and ventilation, Circulation with hemorrhage control, Disability/neurologic assessment, and Exposure/environmental control.

### **Traumatic Bleb**

A filtering bleb formed after glaucoma filtration surgery (trabeculectomy) that develops complications from trauma, or a thin-walled, elevated bleb that leaks or is at risk of rupture. Traumatic bleb failure or overfiltering can lead to hypotony, choroidal detachment, and endophthalmitis risk.

### **Traumatic Brain Injury**

Disruption of brain function caused by an external mechanical force. Severity: mild (GCS 13-15, concussion), moderate (GCS 9-12), severe (GCS 3-8). Primary injury: direct damage at moment of impact (contusion, diffuse axonal injury, intracranial hemorrhage).

#### **Synonyms:**

TBI

### **Traumatic Spondylolisthesis Of The Axis (Hangman's Fracture)**

A bilateral fracture of the pars interarticularis of the C2 vertebra (axis), typically caused by hyper-

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extension of the head. Classically associated with judicial hanging but also occurs in motor vehicle accidents and falls. May present with neck pain, torticollis, or neurological deficits if the spinal cord is compressed.

**Synonyms:**

hangman's fracture

**Treacher Collins Syndrome**

An autosomal dominant craniofacial disorder caused by mutations in TCOF1 (most common), POLR1C, or POLR1D genes, encoding ribosomal RNA transcription factors.

**Treat-To-Target Strategy**

A management approach in which treatment is adjusted at regular intervals toward a predefined goal such as remission or low disease activity. It requires validated disease-activity measures, shared decisions, monitoring, and timely escalation or modification.

**Treatment**

Medical intervention for disease. Includes pharmacological, surgical, lifestyle, supportive.

**Treatment-Resistant Depression**

Depression that does not improve adequately after appropriate trials of standard treatments. It requires reassessment of diagnosis, adherence, comorbidity, and treatment options.

**Trephining (Trepanation)**

A surgical procedure in which a hole is drilled or scraped into the skull (cranium), exposing the dura mater. Historically, trephining dates back to Neolithic times (10,000 BCE) and was performed for ritual, therapeutic (releasing 'evil spirits'), and post-traumatic indications.

**Synonyms:**

Trepanation

**Treponema Pallidum**

A spirochete that causes syphilis, a sexually transmitted infection. The organism is transmitted

through sexual contact or transplacentally (congenital syphilis). Primary syphilis presents with a painless genital ulcer (chancre). Secondary syphilis presents with rash, mucous patches, and condylomata lata.

**Treponema Pallidum Infection**

Infection with the bacterium *Treponema pallidum*, which causes syphilis and can affect the skin, nervous system, cardiovascular system, and other organs.

**Trepopnea**

Dyspnea that occurs in one lateral decubitus position but not the other. It is typically worse when lying on the side of the affected lung. It may be caused by unilateral lung disease, pleural effusion, or mediastinal mass.

**Trial Of Labor After Cesarean**

An attempt to give birth vaginally after a previous cesarean delivery. Whether it is appropriate depends on the prior uterine incision, obstetric history, current pregnancy, facility resources, and the person's preferences. Counseling includes the possibility of successful VBAC, repeat cesarean delivery, and uterine rupture.

**Triceps Brachii Muscle**

Three-headed posterior arm muscle. Long head from infraglenoid tubercle, lateral head from posterior humerus above radial groove, medial head below. All insert on the olecranon. Innervated by radial nerve (C7-C8). Primary elbow extensor; assists shoulder extension/adduction.

**Trichobezoar**

A gastrointestinal mass composed mainly of swallowed hair, usually located in the stomach.

**Trichomonas**

A flagellated protozoan, *Trichomonas vaginalis*, that infects the urogenital tract and causes trichomoniasis. It is transmitted mainly through sexual contact and may cause discharge, irritation, or no symptoms.

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### Trichothiodystrophy Syndrome

A group of inherited disorders characterized by brittle sulfur-deficient hair with a distinctive banded appearance, often accompanied by photosensitivity, ichthyosis, developmental delay, short stature, or recurrent infection.

### Tricuspid Atresia

Absence of the tricuspid valve, resulting in no direct communication between the right atrium and right ventricle. Blood flow depends on an atrial septal defect and ventricular septal defect for mixing. Presents with cyanosis.

### Tricuspid Regurgitation

Incomplete closure of the tricuspid valve allowing blood to flow backward from the right ventricle to the right atrium during systole. Causes include right ventricular dilation (from pulmonary hypertension or left heart failure), endocarditis, rheumatic disease, and carcinoid syndrome.

### Tricyclic Antidepressant Overdose

Anticholinergic effects, cardiac toxicity (QRS prolongation, arrhythmias), seizures, hypotension. Treatment: sodium bicarbonate (QRS >100 ms), seizure control, supportive care.

### Tricyclic Antidepressants

Older antidepressants that non-selectively inhibit the reuptake of serotonin and norepinephrine. They include amitriptyline, nortriptyline, imipramine, clomipramine, and desipramine.

### Trimethoprim-Sulfamethoxazole

A fixed-dose combination of trimethoprim and sulfamethoxazole that synergistically inhibits folate synthesis. TMP-SMX is indicated for urinary tract infections, *Pneumocystis jirovecii* pneumonia, and community-acquired pneumonia. The combination is bactericidal against many gram-positive and gram-negative organisms.

### Trimethylaminuria

A metabolic disorder in which impaired oxidation of trimethylamine causes a characteristic fish-like

body odor in sweat, urine, and breath. It may be inherited or acquired and can cause substantial psychosocial distress despite limited physical illness.

### Trinucleotide Repeat

Expansion of three-nucleotide sequences causes diseases: Huntington (CAG), Fragile X (CGG), myotonic dystrophy (CTG), Friedreich ataxia (GAA). Anticipation common.

### Tripe Palms

Diffuse, velvety, thickened hyperkeratosis of the palmar skin with a cerebriform, corrugated appearance resembling the lining of a cow's stomach (tripe), which is strongly associated with underlying malignancy, most commonly gastric adenocarcinoma. It may occur alone or in conjunction with acanthosis nigricans.

### Triple-Negative Breast Cancer

Breast cancer lacking ER, PR, HER2. Aggressive, limited treatment options.

### Triploidy Syndrome

A chromosomal condition in which cells contain three complete haploid chromosome sets. It causes severe fetal growth restriction and multiple congenital anomalies and is usually incompatible with prolonged survival; partial or mosaic forms vary.

### Triptan

A class of medications used for acute migraine treatment, acting as 5-HT<sub>1B</sub>/1D receptor agonists. 5-HT<sub>1B</sub> receptors are located on cranial blood vessels; activation causes vasoconstriction of dilated meningeal arteries.

### Triquetrum

Pyramidal proximal row carpal bone on the ulnar side, articulating with lunate, hamate, pisiform, and TFCC. Second most commonly fractured carpal bone. Contributes to proximal carpal row and ulnar wrist stability. Pisiform articulates with its volar surface.



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## Trisomy

Presence of three copies of a chromosome instead of two. Trisomy 21 (Down syndrome): intellectual disability, characteristic facies, heart defects. Trisomy 18 (Edwards): severe intellectual disability, multiple anomalies. Trisomy 13 (Patau): severe intellectual disability, holoprosencephaly, cleft lip/palate.

## Trisomy 21

Down syndrome: the most common chromosomal disorder, caused by an extra chromosome 21 (trisomy 21; 95 percent meiotic nondisjunction, mosaicism, translocation).

## Trophoderm

The outer cellular layer of a blastocyst that contributes to formation of the placenta.

## Tropical Sprue

Chronic diarrhea and malabsorption syndrome of uncertain etiology occurring predominantly in tropical and subtropical regions. The condition is characterized by villous atrophy of the small intestinal mucosa leading to malabsorption of nutrients including folate, iron, and vitamin B12.

## Troponin

Cardiac-specific troponin I and T, the preferred biomarkers for myocardial injury (MI). Highly sensitive and specific. Rise 2-4 hours after symptom onset, peak at 12-24 hours, remain elevated for 7-10 days. High-sensitivity troponin (hs-cTn) allows earlier detection (1-2 hours).

## Trousseau Sign Of Latent Tetany

A sensitive and specific clinical sign of hypocalcemia. Elicited by inflating a blood pressure cuff on the upper arm to a pressure greater than systemic systolic blood pressure for 3 minutes.

## Trousseau Syndrome

Recurrent or migratory venous thrombosis associated with active malignancy, particularly mucin-producing adenocarcinoma. It reflects tumor-associated activation of coagulation and is distinct from Trousseau sign of latent tetany.

## True Ribs

Ribs 1-7 articulating directly with the sternum via their own costal cartilages. Each has a head, neck, tubercle, and shaft. The first two are short and strongly curved for neck/shoulder muscle attachment. Costal cartilages provide thoracic cage elasticity for respiratory expansion.

## Truncus Arteriosus

A congenital heart defect where a single large vessel arises from both ventricles, receiving a mixed blood supply. Associated with a large ventricular septal defect and abnormal semilunar valve. Presents with cyanosis and heart failure early in life.

## Trypanosoma Brucei

A protozoan parasite transmitted by tsetse flies that causes African trypanosomiasis, or sleeping sickness. The human-infecting subspecies differ in geographic distribution and typical disease course; infection can progress from fever and lymph-node enlargement to neurologic involvement.

## TSH-Receptor Antibody

An antibody that binds the thyrotropin receptor. Stimulating antibodies cause Graves disease, while blocking antibodies can cause hypothyroidism; measurement supports diagnosis and can help assess fetal or neonatal risk in pregnancy.

## Tubal Ligation

Surgical sterilization by occluding the fallopian tubes, preventing the ovum from reaching the uterus. Postpartum tubal ligation: after vaginal or cesarean delivery (Pomeroy technique, Parkland). Interval: laparoscopic (bands, clips, bipolar cautery) or mini-laparotomy (Hulka or Filshie clip).

## Tuberculin Skin Test

Intradermal injection of purified protein derivative (PPD) to test for Mycobacterium tuberculosis infection. Read at 48-72 hours measuring induration (not erythema). Positive: greater than 5 mm in HIV or close contacts; greater than 10 mm in high-risk groups; greater than 15 mm in low-risk populations.



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### **Tuberculoid Leprosy**

The paucibacillary pole of the leprosy spectrum characterized by strong cell-mediated immunity to *Mycobacterium leprae*, resulting in well-formed granulomas and few or no organisms in tissue.

### **Tuberculosis In Children**

Infection with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, often from household contacts. Latent TB infection (LTBI) positive tuberculin skin test or interferon-gamma release assay with no symptoms or radiographic findings. Active TB presents with cough, fever, weight loss, and lymphadenopathy. Diagnosis by PPD, chest X-ray, and sputum culture.

### **Tuberous Sclerosis Complex**

An autosomal dominant genetic disorder caused by mutations in TSC1 (hamartin) or TSC2 (tuberin) genes, leading to mTOR pathway activation. Features: cortical tubers, subependymal nodules, cardiac rhabdomyomas, angiomyolipomas, facial angiofibromas, and seizures (often infantile spasms).

### **Tubography**

Contrast imaging of fallopian tubes. Evaluates patency.

### **Tubular Reabsorption**

The process by which the renal tubules return filtered water and solutes from the tubular lumen to the blood, reclaiming 99 percent of the glomerular filtrate. Proximal tubule: reabsorbs 65 percent of sodium, most glucose, amino acids, water, bicarbonate, phosphate, and urate.

### **Tubular Secretion**

The transport of substances from the peritubular capillary blood into the tubular lumen, a second mechanism (besides filtration) by which the kidney eliminates waste and regulates ions.

### **Tubuloglomerular Feedback**

A feedback mechanism at the juxtaglomerular apparatus (JGA) that adjusts GFR based on tubular fluid NaCl concentration. The macula densa cells (specialized tubular epithelial cells in the thick

ascending limb) sense NaCl concentration via the NKCC2 cotransporter.

### **Tularemia**

Tularemia is infection with *Francisella tularensis* acquired from ticks, animals, contaminated water, or aerosols and causing ulcer-glandular, pulmonary, or other disease.

### **Tumor**

A neoplastic condition involving tumor; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Tumor Board**

A multidisciplinary conference of oncologists, surgeons, radiologists, and pathologists who review individual cancer cases to coordinate diagnosis and treatment planning.

### **Tumor Burden**

The total amount of cancer in the body, estimated from the number, size, and extent of tumor deposits; higher burden is generally associated with worse prognosis.

### **Tumor Differentiation**

The degree to which neoplastic cells morphologically and functionally resemble their normal counterparts of origin.

### **Tumor Embolism**

Tumor embolism occurs when malignant cells, tumor fragments, or tumor thrombi enter the venous circulation and travel to distant sites. The pulmonary vasculature is the most common site of embolization, as venous blood from most organs drains to the lungs through the pulmonary arteries.

### **Tumor Grade**

A histologic measure of how much tumor cells resemble normal tissue; low-grade (well-differentiated) tumors behave less aggressively than high-grade (poorly differentiated) tumors. Grading is a prognostic, not staging, feature.

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## Tumor Grading

A description of a tumor based on how abnormal the cancer cells look under a microscope compared to normal cells; a lower grade indicates slower-growing cancer.

## Tumor Heterogeneity

The presence of genetically, epigenetically, or phenotypically distinct subpopulations within the same tumor or between primary and metastatic sites. Heterogeneity can influence prognosis, sampling, treatment response, and resistance.

## Tumor Lysis Syndrome

Metabolic emergency from rapid cell death. Hyperuricemia, hyperkalemia, hyperphosphatemia, hypocalcemia. Prevention: hydration, allopurinol, rasburicase.

## Tumor Marker

Substance produced by cancer or body in response to cancer. Used for diagnosis, monitoring, prognosis. Examples: PSA (prostate), CA-125 (ovarian), CEA (colon), AFP (liver), CA 19-9 (pancreas).

## Tumor Microenvironment

Surrounding tissue influencing tumor growth. Includes immune cells, blood vessels, fibroblasts, signaling molecules.

## Tumor Mutational Burden

The number of somatic mutations per unit of coding DNA in a tumor specimen. TMB may correlate with production of neoantigens and response to some immune checkpoint inhibitors, but interpretation requires a validated assay and disease-specific context.

## Tumor Necrosis Factor

A proinflammatory cytokine (TNF-alpha) produced mainly by macrophages, acting on TNFR1/TNFR2 receptors. Functions: activation of endothelium and leukocytes, fever, cachexia, apoptosis, and coordination of inflammation and the acute-phase response.

## Tumor Necrosis Factor Inhibitor

TNF inhibitor (biologic): monoclonal antibodies/fusion proteins blocking TNF-alpha—infliximab, adalimumab (monoclonals), etanercept (soluble receptor), certolizumab, golimumab. Used in rheumatoid arthritis (after methotrexate failure), ankylosing spondylitis, psoriatic arthritis, psoriasis, IBD (Crohn, UC).

## Tumor Staging

A system of describing the size of a cancer and how far it has spread throughout the body from its original location (e.g., using the TNM system).

## Tumor Suppressor

A gene or protein that helps limit cell growth, repair DNA damage, or promote removal of abnormal cells. Loss of its function can contribute to cancer.

## Tumor Suppressor Gene

Gene that prevents uncontrolled cell growth. Examples: TP53, RB1, BRCA1, BRCA2, APC. Loss of function contributes to cancer.

## Tumor-Suppressor Gene

A gene whose normal product restrains cell proliferation, promotes DNA repair, induces apoptosis, or maintains genomic stability. Loss or inactivation of both functional copies is common in the development of many cancers, although mechanisms vary by gene.

## Tungiasis

A skin infestation caused by the sand flea *Tunga* penetrans, producing an itchy or painful lesion, usually on the feet.

## Tunica Adventitia

The outer connective-tissue layer of a blood-vessel wall. It contains collagen and elastic fibers that provide structural support, along with nerves and, in larger vessels, small vessels called vasa vasorum that supply the outer wall. It is relatively prominent in veins and helps anchor vessels to surrounding tissues.

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## **Tunica Media**

The middle layer of a blood-vessel wall, located between the tunica intima and tunica adventitia. It consists primarily of smooth muscle and elastic fibers; its contraction or relaxation changes vascular diameter, regulating blood pressure and tissue perfusion. It is thickest in arteries and thinner in veins.

## **Turbinates**

Curved bony shelves on the lateral walls of the nasal cavity, covered by vascular mucosa. They increase surface area and help warm, humidify, and filter inhaled air.

## **Turbinates Hypertrophy**

Chronic enlargement of the nasal turbinates, most commonly the inferior turbinates, resulting in nasal airway obstruction, which can be caused by chronic inflammation from allergic rhinitis, non-allergic rhinitis, chronic sinusitis, hormonal changes, or vasomotor dysfunction.

## **Turner Hypoplasia**

Enamel defect on permanent tooth from infection of overlying primary tooth. Localized hypoplasia.

## **Turner Syndrome**

A chromosomal condition, most commonly with a 45,X karyotype but also with mosaic or structurally abnormal X chromosomes. It typically causes short stature and gonadal dysgenesis with ovarian insufficiency; associated findings include webbed neck, broad chest, bicuspid aortic valve, coarctation of the aorta, renal anomalies, hearing problems, and autoimmune thyroid disease.

## **Twin-To-Twin Transfusion Syndrome**

A complication of monochorionic twin pregnancy in which shared placental vessels cause unequal blood flow between the twins.

## **Twin-Twin Transfusion Syndrome**

A complication of monochorionic diamniotic twin pregnancies where placental vascular anastomoses (arteriovenous connections) cause unbalanced blood

flow from one twin (the donor) to the other (the recipient). The donor twin becomes hypovolemic, anemic, and growth-restricted with oligohydramnios ("stuck twin").

## **Tympanic Cavity**

The air-filled space of the middle ear containing the malleus, incus, and stapes.

## **Tympanic Hyperectasis**

Abnormal outward bulging or retraction of the tympanic membrane from chronic middle ear pressure changes, potentially causing conductive hearing loss and requiring tympanostomy tube placement.

## **Tympanometry**

Tympanometry examines tympanometry; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. membrane and the pressure within the middle ear as a function of air pressure in the external auditory canal, providing information about middle ear function that supplements otoscopic examination.

## **Tympanosclerosis**

Scarring and calcification of the tympanic membrane or middle-ear lining, often following recurrent infection or previous inflammation. It may be asymptomatic or cause conductive hearing loss when the ossicles are affected.

### **Synonyms:**

Tympanic-membrane sclerosis; myringosclerosis when limited to the tympanic membrane.

## **Tympanostomy Tubes**

Small tubes inserted through the tympanic membrane to ventilate the middle ear and prevent fluid accumulation. Indicated for recurrent acute otitis media (3 episodes in 6 months or 4 in 12 months) or persistent otitis media with effusion greater than 3 months with hearing loss. Performed as outpatient procedure under general anesthesia.

## **Type 1 Diabetes Mellitus**

Type 1 diabetes is an autoimmune disease in which the immune system attacks and destroys the insulin-

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producing beta cells of the pancreas, resulting in absolute insulin deficiency.

### **Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus**

Type 2 diabetes is a chronic metabolic disorder characterized by insulin resistance and progressive pancreatic beta-cell dysfunction, leading to hyperglycemia.

### **Type I Hypersensitivity**

An immediate (anaphylactic) hypersensitivity reaction mediated by allergen-specific IgE bound to mast cells and basophils; re-exposure cross-links IgE, triggering degranulation and release of histamine and mediators within minutes. Manifestations: allergic rhinitis, asthma, urticaria, food allergy, and anaphylaxis.

### **Type II Hypersensitivity**

An antibody-mediated (cytotoxic) hypersensitivity reaction in which IgG or IgM binds to cell-surface or matrix antigens, causing cell destruction by complement activation (MAC), opsonization/phagocytosis, or antibody-dependent cellular cytotoxicity.

### **Type III Hypersensitivity**

An immune complex-mediated hypersensitivity reaction in which circulating antigen-antibody complexes deposit in tissues and vessels, activating complement and attracting neutrophils, causing inflammation and tissue damage. Local forms: Arthus reaction, serum sickness.

### **Type III Hypersensitivity Reaction**

Tissue injury caused by deposition of antigen-antibody complexes, activating complement and inflammation.

### **Type IV Hypersensitivity**

A delayed-type hypersensitivity (cell-mediated) reaction mediated by sensitized T cells (not antibody), occurring 24-72 hours after antigen exposure.

### **Typhlitis**

Inflammation of the cecum in immunocompromised

patients particularly those with neutropenia from chemotherapy. Also known as neutropenic enterocolitis. Presents with right lower quadrant pain, fever, and diarrhea. Diagnosis is by CT showing cecal wall thickening.

#### **Synonyms:**

neutropenic enterocolitis.

### **Typhoid**

A systemic infection caused by *Salmonella enterica* serovar Typhi, usually acquired through contaminated food or water and characterized by prolonged fever and gastrointestinal or systemic symptoms.

### **Typhus**

Typhus refers to several rickettsial infections transmitted by lice, fleas, or mites and characterized by fever, headache, rash, and variable systemic complications. arthropod vectors. Three main forms: (1) Epidemic (louse-borne) typhus—*Rickettsia prowazekii*, transmitted by the human body louse (*Pediculus humanus corporis*). Associated with overcrowding, poverty, cold climate, and refugees ('war typhus').

### **Typical Antipsychotics**

Typical antipsychotics, also known as first-generation antipsychotics, primarily block dopamine D2 receptors in the mesolimbic pathway, reducing positive symptoms of schizophrenia including hallucinations, delusions, and disorganized thinking.

#### **Synonyms:**

first-generation antipsychotics, primarily block.

### **Tyrosine Kinase Inhibitor**

A class of targeted cancer therapy drugs that inhibit tyrosine kinases, enzymes that phosphorylate tyrosine residues on proteins and activate signaling pathways involved in cell growth, proliferation, differentiation, and survival. Tyrosine kinase mutations or overexpression drive many cancers.

### **Tyrosinemia**

An inherited disorder of tyrosine metabolism that causes accumulation of tyrosine or its metabolites. Type I can cause severe liver and kidney disease and

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is associated with fumarylacetoacetate hydrolase deficiency.

### **Tonic Seizures**

Seizures that cause sustained stiffening of muscles, usually lasting seconds to minutes.

### **Traumatic Shock**

A life-threatening state in which severe injury causes inadequate blood flow and oxygen delivery to tissues.

### **Trendelenburg Position**

A supine position in which the head and upper body are lower than the feet.

### **Teen Depression**

A depressive disorder in an adolescent that causes persistent low mood or loss of interest and impairs daily functioning.

#### **Synonyms:**

Depression, Teen

### **Temporal Lobe Seizure**

A seizure that begins in the temporal lobe of the brain and may cause altered awareness, unusual sensations, or repetitive movements.

#### **Synonyms:**

Seizure, Temporal Lobe

### **Tendinopathy**

A disorder involving tendon pain and impaired tendon structure, usually related to overuse or degeneration.

### **Tuberculin Test**

A skin test that assesses whether the immune system has reacted to tuberculosis proteins.

### **Towel Clamp**

A clamp used to secure surgical drapes or hold them in position.

### **Tactile Sense**

The ability to perceive touch, pressure, vibration,

texture, and related mechanical stimuli through receptors in the skin and deeper tissues.

### **Target Tissue**

A tissue containing receptors or other molecular targets on which a hormone, drug, toxin, or signaling molecule acts.

### **Tarsorrhaphy**

A procedure that partially or completely closes the eyelids to protect the cornea or reduce exposure in conditions such as severe dry eye or facial nerve palsy.

### **Testes**

Testes examines testes; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Thyroxine-Binding Globulin**

The principal transport protein for thyroid hormones in the blood, binding most circulating thyroxine and triiodothyronine.

### **Tissue Plasminogen Activator**

An enzyme that converts plasminogen to plasmin, helping dissolve fibrin in blood clots. Recombinant forms are used as thrombolytic medicines in selected emergencies.

### **Tomosynthesis**

An imaging technique that acquires multiple low-dose X-ray projections and reconstructs thin section images, commonly used for three-dimensional breast imaging.

### **Tonometer**

An instrument used to measure intraocular pressure, an important part of glaucoma assessment.

### **Tonus**

The normal resting partial contraction of a muscle or the baseline tension of a tissue.

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## **Tussis**

Cough; a forceful reflex expiration that helps clear secretions, irritants, or foreign material from the airways.

## **Tenodesis**

Surgical fixation of a tendon to bone or another tendon to restore function, stabilize a joint, or treat tendon imbalance.

## **Tibial Fracture**

A break in the tibia, the major weight-bearing bone of the lower leg, often caused by high-energy trauma, twisting injury, or repetitive stress.

## **Transaminitis**

Elevation of blood levels of aminotransferase enzymes, usually alanine aminotransferase and aspartate aminotransferase, indicating possible liver-cell injury but not identifying its cause.

## **Travelers' Diarrhea**

Acute diarrhea occurring during or shortly after travel, usually caused by contaminated food or water and commonly involving bacterial, viral, or parasitic infection.

## **Tubular Adenoma**

A benign glandular polyp, most often in the colon, that can develop dysplastic changes and is considered a precursor lesion for some colorectal cancers.

## **Tympanoplasty**

Surgical repair or reconstruction of the tympanic membrane and, when necessary, the middle-ear ossicles to close a perforation or improve hearing.

## **Tympanic Membrane Perforation**

A tear or hole in the eardrum caused by infection, trauma, pressure changes, or instrumentation, potentially producing pain, drainage, or conductive hearing loss.

## **Tachycardia-Induced Cardiomyopathy**

Weakening and dilation of the heart muscle caused

by a persistent or frequently recurring rapid heart rhythm, often improving when the arrhythmia is controlled.

## **Toxic Metabolic Encephalopathy**

Diffuse brain dysfunction caused by systemic metabolic or toxic disturbances, producing confusion, altered alertness, agitation, seizures, or coma.

## **Tensile Strength**

The ability of a tissue or material to resist being pulled apart; it is important in wound healing and the integrity of sutures, tendons, and other connective tissues.

## **Terminal Care**

Care focused on comfort, symptom relief, dignity, and support for a person with an advanced illness who is approaching the end of life.

## **Terry's Nails**

A nail change in which most of the nail plate appears white with a narrow pink or brown distal band; it may be associated with liver disease, heart failure, diabetes, or ageing.

## **Tetraplegia (Quadriplegia)**

Paralysis or severe weakness affecting all four limbs and usually the trunk, commonly caused by cervical spinal-cord injury or disease.

### **Synonyms:**

Quadriplegia

## **Thoracoscopy**

A minimally invasive procedure using a camera inserted through the chest wall to examine or treat the pleura, lungs, or mediastinum.

## **Threadworms (Pinworms)**

Small intestinal worms, *Enterobius vermicularis*, whose females lay eggs around the anus and commonly cause nocturnal itching.

### **Synonyms:**

Pinworms



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### **Transient Ischaemic Attack (TIA)**

A brief episode of neurological dysfunction caused by temporary focal brain, spinal-cord, or retinal ischaemia without persistent tissue infarction.

#### **Synonyms:**

TIA

### **Tick-Borne Encephalitis**

A viral infection transmitted mainly by ticks that can cause fever, meningitis, encephalitis, or lasting neurological complications.

### **Tiredness (Fatigue)**

A subjective lack of energy or exhaustion that may result from inadequate sleep, illness, psychological stress, anaemia, or many other causes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Fatigue

### **Tongue-Tie (Ankyloglossia)**

Restricted movement of the tongue caused by an unusually short or tight lingual frenulum, sometimes affecting feeding, speech, or oral hygiene.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ankyloglossia

### **Tropical Chronic Pancreatitis**

A historically recognized form of chronic pancreatitis reported mainly in tropical and subtropical regions, often beginning at a younger age and associated with recurrent abdominal pain, pancreatic duct stones, and diabetes. Its causes are multifactorial and may include genetic susceptibility, nutritional factors, and environmental exposures; the term should not be applied solely because a patient lives in a tropical region.

### **Tumour (Neoplasm)**

An abnormal mass of tissue produced by uncontrolled or inappropriate cell growth; it may be benign or malignant.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neoplasm

### **Tzanck Smear**

A microscopic examination of cells from the base of a skin blister or erosion, historically used to support diagnoses such as herpesvirus infection or pemphigus.

### **Twin Pregnancy**

A pregnancy involving two fetuses. Clinical risk depends on chorionicity and amnionicity, with increased risks including preterm birth, fetal growth problems, and hypertensive disorders.

### **TAC Regimen**

A medical term referring to tac regimen. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tacedinaline**

Tacedinaline is an investigational histone-deacetylase inhibitor studied for effects on gene expression and cancer-cell growth.

### **Tachykinin**

A biological or biochemical term involving tachykinin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Tachyphrenia**

Tachyphrenia is rapid flow of thoughts or accelerated mental activity, often described in association with mania, stimulants, or other psychiatric states.

### **Tacrine**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called tacrine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Tactile Agnosia**

Tactile agnosia is inability to recognize a familiar object by touch despite intact primary sensation, usually from parietal-cortex dysfunction.

### **Tadalafil**

Tadalafil is a phosphodiesterase-5 inhibitor used for erectile dysfunction, benign prostatic hyperplasia, and pulmonary hypertension; headache, flushing,

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hypotension, priapism, and dangerous nitrate interactions are important risks.

### **Taenia Saginata**

*Taenia saginata* is the beef tapeworm acquired from undercooked infected beef; intestinal infection may cause abdominal symptoms or passage of motile segments but does not usually cause human cysticercosis.

### **Taenia Solium**

*Taenia solium* is the pork tapeworm; eating undercooked pork causes intestinal taeniasis, while ingesting eggs can cause cysticercosis, including potentially serious neurocysticercosis.

### **Talabostat**

Talabostat is an investigational inhibitor of fibroblast activation protein and related enzymes studied for immune and anticancer effects.

### **Talactoferrin Alfa**

Talactoferrin alfa is a recombinant lactoferrin-related immunomodulatory protein studied as a treatment or adjunct in cancer and infectious disease.

### **Talaporfin Sodium**

Talaporfin sodium is a photosensitizer used or studied in photodynamic therapy, where light activation produces local cytotoxic effects.

### **Talipes Calcaneovalgus**

A foot deformity in which the heel is turned outward and the ankle is dorsiflexed so the foot points upward; flexible newborn cases often improve, while rigid cases need evaluation.

### **Tall Stature**

Tall stature means height substantially above the expected range for age and sex and may be familial, endocrine, genetic, or associated with another condition.

### **Talotrexin**

Talotrexin is an investigational antifolate antineoplastic drug designed to inhibit folate-dependent cellular metabolism.

### **Tamoxifen Citrate**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called tamoxifen citrate. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Tamsulosin**

Tamsulosin is a selective alpha-1A blocker that relaxes prostate and bladder-neck smooth muscle to improve urinary symptoms of benign prostatic hyperplasia; dizziness, postural hypotension, and ejaculatory dysfunction may occur.

### **Tamsulosin Hydrochloride**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called tamsulosin hydrochloride. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Tandutinib**

A medical term referring to tandutinib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tanespimycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called tanespimycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Tannic Acid**

A plant-derived polyphenol with astringent and protein-binding properties, used in some industrial or historical preparations; concentrated ingestion can irritate the gastrointestinal tract and affect absorption.

### **Tanomastat**

Tanomastat is an investigational matrix-metalloproteinase inhibitor studied for reducing tumor invasion and tissue remodeling.

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### **Tantalum**

A biological or biochemical term involving tantalum. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Tapentadol**

Tapentadol is a centrally acting analgesic with mu-opioid agonist and norepinephrine-reuptake-inhibitory effects, used for moderate-to-severe pain; respiratory depression, dependence, seizures, and serotonin or sedative interactions are possible.

### **Taq Polymerase**

A biological or biochemical term involving taq polymerase. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Tarenflurbil**

Tarenflurbil is an investigational derivative of flurbiprofen studied for effects on amyloid processing and Alzheimer disease.

### **Tariquidar**

Tariquidar is an investigational inhibitor of the P-glycoprotein drug transporter studied to reverse multidrug resistance and alter medicine distribution.

### **Tarsal Bones**

The seven bones of the hindfoot and midfoot that connect the ankle to the metatarsals and form the arches and load-bearing framework of the foot.

### **Tarsal Joints**

The articulations among the tarsal bones and between the tarsals and metatarsals, providing stability and controlled movement for walking and adapting the foot to surfaces.

### **Taste Bud**

A taste bud is a cluster of specialized sensory cells in papillae of the tongue and some oral tissues that detects sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami stimuli and transmits signals through cranial nerves.

### **Taste Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving taste disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Tenascin**

A biological or biochemical term involving tenascin. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Tendon Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving tendon injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Tendon Sheath**

A medical term referring to tendon sheath. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tenericutes**

A biological or biochemical term involving tenericutes. Its role depends on the relevant cells, molecules, and physiological process.

### **Teniposide**

Teniposide is a podophyllotoxin-derived antineoplastic drug that inhibits topoisomerase II and is used in selected leukemia or lymphoma regimens.

### **Tenofovir**

Tenofovir is a nucleotide reverse-transcriptase inhibitor used with other medicines for HIV and as treatment or prevention for hepatitis B; renal and bone toxicity and formulation-specific monitoring are important.

### **Tension-Type Headache**

A usually bilateral, pressing or tightening headache of mild-to-moderate intensity without prominent nausea, often associated with stress, muscle tenderness, or poor sleep.

### **Tenuazonic Acid**

A mycotoxin produced by some fungi that contami-

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nates certain plants and foods and can inhibit protein synthesis; toxicity depends on exposure and the producing organism.

### **Teprotumumab**

A medical term referring to teprotumumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Terameprocol**

Terameprocol is an investigational anticancer compound that affects transcription factors and cell-survival pathways.

### **Teratocarcinoma**

A neoplasm involving teratocarcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Teratozoospermia**

Teratozoospermia is a high proportion of abnormally shaped sperm and may contribute to reduced fertility, though semen results must be interpreted as a whole.

### **Terazosin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called terazosin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Terazosin Hydrochloride**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called terazosin hydrochloride. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Terbufos**

Terbufos is a highly toxic organophosphate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause severe cholinergic poisoning.

### **Terfenadine**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called terfenadine. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and

patient.

### **Terlipressin**

Terlipressin is a vasopressin analogue that constricts splanchnic vessels and is used in selected cases of variceal bleeding or hepatorenal syndrome.

### **Term Birth**

Term birth occurs at or after 37 completed weeks of pregnancy; early term, full term, and late or post-term categories describe more specific gestational ranges.

### **Terminal Insomnia**

Waking too early and being unable to return to sleep, a pattern that can occur in depression, circadian-rhythm disorders, aging, or other insomnia conditions.

### **Terpene**

A terpene is a hydrocarbon built from isoprene units and found in plant oils, fragrances, medicines, and other natural products.

### **Tertiary Hyperparathyroidism**

Autonomous overproduction of parathyroid hormone after long-standing secondary hyperparathyroidism, usually in chronic kidney disease, causing high calcium and high PTH.

### **Tertiary Protein**

The three-dimensional folding of a single protein chain, created by interactions among amino-acid side chains and determining the protein's functional shape.

### **Tesetaxel**

Tesetaxel is an investigational oral taxane that disrupts microtubules and has been studied as an anti-cancer treatment.

### **Testicular Atrophy**

Shrinkage and loss of functional tissue in a testicle caused by undescended testis, infection, torsion, trauma, varicocele, hormones, aging, or other injury.

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### **Testicular Feminization**

An older term for complete or partial androgen-insensitivity syndrome, in which a person with XY chromosomes has reduced cellular response to androgens and typically female external development.

### **Testicular Gonadoblastoma**

A rare mixed germ-cell and sex-cord tumor arising in a dysgenetic or undescended gonad, often associated with Y-chromosome material and risk of another germ-cell tumor.

### **Testicular Hydrocele**

A collection of clear fluid around a testicle within the tunica vaginalis, causing painless scrotal enlargement that transilluminates; it may be congenital, reactive, or secondary to disease.

### **Testicular Mass**

A lump or enlargement within or around a testicle caused by tumor, infection, inflammation, cyst, hematoma, or torsion; a solid intratesticular mass requires urgent ultrasound and specialist assessment.

### **Testis Disorder**

A condition affecting a testicle, including torsion, infection, tumor, trauma, infertility-related damage, hormonal dysfunction, or abnormal development.

### **Testis Neoplasm**

A tumor arising in testicular tissue, most commonly a germ-cell tumor in younger adults; painless enlargement, heaviness, or a solid mass requires prompt ultrasound and evaluation.

### **Testolactone**

An aromatase inhibitor formerly used to reduce estrogen production in selected endocrine conditions; current use is limited by availability and newer alternatives.

### **Testosterone Propionate**

A short-acting injectable testosterone ester used in selected hormone-replacement or androgen-deficiency settings; risks include erythrocytosis, in-

fertility, acne, mood effects, and prostate-related monitoring needs.

### **Tetanus Toxin**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving tetanus toxin; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Tetracaine**

Tetracaine is a potent ester local anaesthetic used topically or for spinal anaesthesia; excessive dose can cause seizures, cardiovascular toxicity, and methemoglobinaemia.

### **Tetrachloroethylene**

Tetrachloroethylene, or perchloroethylene, is an industrial solvent used in dry cleaning; substantial exposure can affect the nervous system, liver, and kidneys.

### **Tetrachlorvinphos**

Tetrachlorvinphos is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

### **Thyrotroph Adenoma**

A neoplasm involving thyrotroph adenoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Thyrotropin**

A medical term referring to thyrotropin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Thyrotropin Alfa**

A medical term referring to thyrotropin alfa. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tiazofurin**

Tiazofurin is an investigational nucleoside analogue that interferes with NAD synthesis and has been studied as an antineoplastic agent.

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### **Tibia Vara**

Tibia vara is inward angulation of the upper shin-bone causing bowing of the leg, classically associated with Blount disease or other growth disorders.

### **Tibial Artery**

An artery of the lower leg, chiefly the anterior and posterior tibial arteries, supplying the leg, ankle, and foot and contributing to pedal pulses.

### **Tibialcrural Artery**

A lower-leg arterial vessel or branching region supplying the ankle and foot, usually discussed in relation to tibial and fibular arterial anatomy.

### **Tibialis Cranialis**

The animal-anatomy term corresponding broadly to the tibialis anterior muscle, which dorsiflexes the ankle and helps invert the foot.

### **Tic Disorder**

A clinical condition or finding involving tic disorder. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Ticarcillin**

A medical term referring to ticarcillin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tick**

A medical term referring to tick. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tigecycline**

Tigecycline is a glycylcycline antibiotic that binds the bacterial 30S ribosomal subunit and inhibits protein synthesis; it treats selected complicated infections but commonly causes nausea and has a warning for increased mortality in some severe infections.

### **Tight Junction**

A cell-to-cell junction that seals the space between epithelial cells and controls paracellular movement while helping maintain distinct apical and basal cell

surfaces.

### **Tilorone**

Tilorone is a synthetic antiviral and immune-modulating compound used or studied in some countries; evidence and indications vary by setting.

### **Timolol**

Timolol is a non-selective beta blocker used in glaucoma eye drops and for selected cardiovascular conditions; topical ocular use can still cause bradycardia, hypotension, bronchospasm, or fatigue.

### **Tinea Favosa**

A medical term referring to tinea favosa. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tinidazole**

Tinidazole is a nitroimidazole antimicrobial effective against anaerobic bacteria and protozoa such as *Giardia* and *Trichomonas*; metallic taste, gastrointestinal effects, neuropathy, and an alcohol interaction may occur.

### **Tinzaparin**

A medical term referring to tinzaparin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tinzaparin Sodium**

A medical term referring to tinzaparin sodium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tiopronin**

A medical term referring to tiopronin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tipifarnib**

A medical term referring to tipifarnib. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tirapazamine**

Tirapazamine is an investigational prodrug activated in low-oxygen tissue and studied to target hypoxic tumor cells.



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### **Tirbanibulin**

A medical term referring to tirbanibulin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tirofiban**

A medical term referring to tirofiban. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tissierella**

A medical term referring to tissierella. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tissierella Praeacuta**

A medical term referring to tissierella praeacuta. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tissue Adhesions**

Bands of fibrous scar tissue that abnormally connect surfaces or organs, often after surgery, inflammation, infection, or bleeding and potentially causing pain, infertility, or obstruction.

### **Tissue Banks**

Facilities that recover, screen, process, preserve, store, and distribute donated human tissue for transplantation, research, or reconstructive treatment under safety and traceability standards.

### **Tissue Congestion**

Accumulation of blood or fluid within tissue because of impaired venous drainage, inflammation, obstruction, or increased vascular flow, producing swelling, redness, or impaired function.

### **Tissue Culture**

Growth of cells or tissue outside the body in a controlled nutrient medium for research, diagnosis, vaccine production, regenerative medicine, or drug testing.

### **Tissue Elastance**

The change in pressure required to produce a given change in tissue or organ volume, the inverse of compliance and important in lung and chest-wall

mechanics.

### **Tissue Engineering**

Application of biology and engineering to create biological substitutes that restore, maintain, or improve tissue function; used in regenerative medicine. Its significance is established from its characteristic features, causes, and clinical context.

### **Tissue Kallikrein**

A serine protease that cleaves kininogen to release kinins such as bradykinin, influencing local blood flow, vascular permeability, pain, and inflammation.

### **Tissue Membrane**

A thin sheet or boundary of tissue that separates compartments, covers surfaces, or surrounds structures, with composition and function varying by epithelial, connective, muscle, or biologic membrane type.

### **Tissue Processor**

A laboratory instrument that moves tissue through fixation, dehydration, clearing, and paraffin infiltration before embedding and microscopic sectioning.

### **Tissue Scaffold**

A natural or engineered three-dimensional framework that supports cell attachment, growth, organization, and tissue repair in regenerative medicine.

### **Tissue Transglutaminase (tTG)**

An enzyme that cross-links proteins and serves as the principal autoantigen in celiac disease; IgA antibodies against tissue transglutaminase are commonly used in celiac disease evaluation.

### **Tmax**

A medical term referring to tmax. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tobacco Use**

Tobacco use exposes the body to nicotine and toxic combustion or aerosol chemicals, causing addiction and increased risks of cancer, vascular disease, and

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lung disease.

### **Tocolytic Agents**

Tocolytic agents suppress uterine contractions temporarily to delay preterm birth, often allowing time for corticosteroids or transfer to specialist care.

### **Tocopherol**

A medical term referring to tocopherol. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tocotrienols**

A medical term referring to tocotrienols. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Togaviridae**

togaviridae is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Togaviridae Infections**

togaviridae infections is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features; clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Tolazamide**

A medical term referring to tolazamide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tolcapone**

A medical term referring to tolcapone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tolmetin**

A medical term referring to tolmetin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tolnaftate**

A medical term referring to tolnaftate. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tolonium Chloride**

Tolonium chloride, or toluidine blue, is a dye used in laboratory and selected clinical procedures to highlight cells or tissue changes.

### **Tolterodine Tartrate**

Tolterodine tartrate is an antimuscarinic medicine used for overactive bladder and urinary urgency; dry mouth, constipation, and urinary retention can occur.

### **Toluene**

Toluene is a volatile solvent that can irritate tissues and, with substantial inhalation or ingestion, injure the nervous system, liver, kidneys, or heart.

### **Tolvaptan**

A medical term referring to tolvaptan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tomotherapy**

tomotherapy is used in relation to tomotherapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Tongue Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving tongue carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Tongue Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving tongue disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Tongue Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving tongue neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Tonic Pupil**

A tonic pupil is a pupil with poor light response but a slow constriction to near focus, often caused by injury to postganglionic parasympathetic fibers.

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### **Tonsillar Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving tonsillar neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Tooth Abrasion**

Loss of tooth substance caused by external mechanical friction, such as aggressive brushing, abrasive products, or habits, producing grooves, notches, or sensitivity.

### **Tooth Ankylosis**

Fusion of a tooth root to alveolar bone through loss of the periodontal ligament, preventing normal eruption and making the tooth appear infraoccluded as neighboring teeth grow.

### **Tooth Attrition**

Wear of tooth surfaces caused by tooth-to-tooth contact, commonly from chewing, bruxism, or malocclusion, producing flattened cusps and possible sensitivity.

### **Tooth Calcification**

Deposition of mineral that forms and hardens enamel, dentin, cementum, and other tooth structures during development; abnormal timing or amount can affect tooth strength and appearance.

### **Tooth Component**

Tooth components include enamel, dentin, cementum, pulp, and supporting tissues, each contributing to tooth strength, sensation, nutrition, and attachment.

### **Tooth Crowding**

Tooth crowding occurs when teeth lack enough space to align normally, often from tooth size, jaw size, eruption pattern, or retained primary teeth.

### **Tooth Crown**

The tooth crown is the visible portion above the gum, covered mainly by hard enamel and containing underlying dentin and pulp.

### **Tooth Discoloration**

Change in tooth color caused by surface stains, dental decay, trauma, medications, fluorosis, aging, or changes within enamel or dentin.

### **Tooth Disease**

A clinical condition or finding involving tooth disease. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Tooth Enamel**

Tooth enamel is the highly mineralized outer covering of the crown that protects dentin and pulp from wear, acid, and bacteria.

### **Tooth Extraction**

Removal of a tooth from its socket because of severe decay, infection, periodontal disease, fracture, impaction, orthodontic planning, or another clinical indication.

### **Tooth Fracture**

A clinical condition or finding involving tooth fracture. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Tooth Loss**

Tooth loss is absence of a tooth due to decay, gum disease, trauma, developmental absence, or extraction and can affect chewing, speech, and oral health.

### **Tooth Resorption**

Loss of dental hard tissue caused by odontoclast activity, occurring internally or on the root surface and associated with trauma, infection, orthodontics, or idiopathic disease.

### **Tooth Root**

The tooth root anchors a tooth in its socket and contains dentin, cementum, pulp, nerves, and blood vessels beneath the gum.

### **Topiramate**

Topiramate is an antiseizure medicine also used to prevent migraine; cognitive slowing, paresthesias,

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weight loss, kidney stones, metabolic acidosis, and fetal oral-cleft risk are important considerations.

### **Topoisomerase II**

A medical term referring to topoisomerase ii. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Topoisomerase Inhibitors**

A medical term referring to topoisomerase inhibitors. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Topotecan**

A medical term referring to topotecan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Topotecan Hydrochloride**

A medical term referring to topotecan hydrochloride. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Toremifene**

A medical term referring to toremifene. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Torsade De Pointes**

Torsade de pointes is a potentially fatal polymorphic ventricular tachycardia associated with prolonged QT, electrolyte disturbance, medicines, or inherited channel disorders.

### **Torsemide**

Torsemide is a loop diuretic that inhibits sodium-potassium-chloride reabsorption in the thick ascending limb and treats oedema from heart, kidney, or liver disease; dehydration and electrolyte loss may occur.

### **Torsion Dystonia**

A movement disorder causing sustained or repetitive muscle contractions that twist the body or limbs into abnormal postures; it may be inherited, acquired, focal, or generalized.

### **Torulaspora**

A medical term referring to torulaspora. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Torulaspora Delbrueckii**

A medical term referring to torulaspora delbrueckii. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tositumomab**

A medical term referring to tositumomab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Total Laryngectomy**

total laryngectomy is used in relation to total laryngectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Total Pancreatectomy**

total pancreatectomy is used in relation to total pancreatectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Toxaphene**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxaphene; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxic Effect**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxic effect; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxicity Grade**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxicity grade; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxicity Test**

toxicity test refers to harmful exposure to the named substance or condition; severity depends on dose, route, timing, symptoms, and patient factors, and

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urgent professional assessment may be required.

### **Toxicogenomics**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxicogenomics; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxicokinetic Description**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxicokinetic description; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxocara**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxocara; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxocara Canis**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxocara canis; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxocara Cati**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxocara cati; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Toxoplasma**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving toxoplasma; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Tra Gene**

A gene involved in sex determination and sexual differentiation in some organisms, especially insects; its function and sequence vary by species.

### **Trabectedin**

Trabectedin is an antineoplastic drug that binds DNA and alters transcription and repair, used for

selected advanced soft-tissue sarcomas and ovarian cancer.

### **Trabulsiella**

A medical term referring to trabulsiella. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Trabulsiella Guamensis**

A medical term referring to trabulsiella guamensis. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Transitional Epithelium**

Specialized stretchable epithelium lining the renal pelvis, ureters, bladder, and proximal urethra, allowing urinary organs to expand while maintaining a protective barrier.

### **Translation Initiation**

The first stage of protein synthesis, when a ribosome recognizes messenger RNA, selects the start codon, and assembles the initiator transfer RNA and ribosomal subunits.

### **Transmembrane Transport**

Movement of ions, nutrients, drugs, or other molecules across a cell membrane through channels, carriers, pumps, or vesicles, sometimes requiring energy.

### **Transmission**

Passage of an infection, signal, genetic trait, force, or substance from one source to another; in infectious disease, route, dose, and host susceptibility determine risk.

### **Transplant**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transplant; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Transplantation Conditioning**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transplantation conditioning; indi-

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cations, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Transplantation Immunology**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transplantation immunology; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Transport Protein**

A membrane or soluble protein that carries a molecule or ion across a membrane or through body fluids, often determining absorption, distribution, and cellular concentration.

### **Transport Vesicle**

A transport vesicle is a membrane-bound carrier that moves proteins, lipids, or other cargo between cellular compartments.

### **Transtracheal**

Transtracheal means passing through or relating to the trachea, such as a catheter, oxygen delivery route, or diagnostic procedure.

### **Transtympanic**

Transtympanic means passing through the tympanic membrane, such as medicine delivered into the middle ear or a procedure crossing the eardrum.

### **Trapezoid Bone**

A small distal-row carpal bone between the trapezium and capitate that articulates mainly with the index metacarpal and helps stabilize the radial side of the hand.

### **Trastuzumab**

Trastuzumab is a monoclonal antibody targeting HER2 used for HER2-positive breast, gastric, and other cancers; infusion reactions and potentially reversible cardiomyopathy require cardiac monitoring.

### **Traumatic Injury**

A clinical condition or finding involving traumatic injury. Its features, causes, evaluation, and manage-

ment depend on the clinical context.

### **Traumeel S**

Traumeel S is a multi-ingredient complementary product marketed for pain and inflammation; evidence, formulation, and safety depend on the product and it should not replace needed care.

### **Travoprost**

Travoprost is a prostaglandin analogue eye drop that increases uveoscleral outflow and lowers intraocular pressure in glaucoma or ocular hypertension; iris pigmentation and eyelash changes may occur.

### **Trazodone**

Trazodone is a serotonin antagonist and reuptake inhibitor used for depression and sometimes insomnia; sedation, orthostatic hypotension, serotonin syndrome, and rare priapism are important adverse effects.

### **Trb Gene**

A gene involved in biological processes that vary by species; its precise identity and function must be interpreted from the organism and gene nomenclature used.

### **Trd Gene**

The gene encoding the delta chain of the T-cell receptor in humans, contributing to gamma-delta T-cell antigen recognition.

### **Treatment Epoch**

treatment epoch is used in relation to treatment epoch during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Trematoda**

A medical term referring to trematoda. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Trematosphaeria Grisea**

A medical term referring to trematosphaeria grisea. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.



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### **Tremelimumab**

A medical term referring to tremelimumab. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Trendelenburg**

Trendelenburg position places the body supine with the feet higher than the head; its use is procedure-specific and may affect breathing, pressure, and circulation.

### **Treosulfan**

A medical term referring to treosulfan. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Trephine**

A medical term referring to trephine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Treponemal Infections**

An infectious process or toxic exposure involving treponemal infections; diagnosis considers the cause, route of exposure, affected tissues, severity, and host response.

### **Tretinoin**

Tretinoin is all-trans retinoic acid used topically for acne and photoaging and orally with arsenic or chemotherapy for acute promyelocytic leukaemia; skin irritation and systemic differentiation syndrome are important risks.

### **TRG Gene**

A gene encoding the gamma chain of the T-cell receptor, contributing to gamma-delta T-cell development and antigen recognition.

### **Trial Indication**

The disease, condition, symptom, or clinical purpose for which an investigational intervention is being studied in a clinical trial.

### **Trial Screening**

The process of checking potential participants against a clinical trial's eligibility criteria, including

medical history, examination, laboratory tests, and informed consent.

### **Triamcinolone Acetonide**

A medical term referring to triamcinolone acetonide. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Triamterene**

Triamterene is a potassium-sparing diuretic that blocks epithelial sodium channels in the collecting duct and is used for hypertension or oedema; hyperkalaemia and kidney stones are important risks.

### **Triazenes**

A medical term referring to triazenes. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Triazine**

A medical term referring to triazine. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Triaziquone**

A medical term referring to triaziquone. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Triazolam**

Triazolam is a short-acting benzodiazepine hypnotic for short-term insomnia; amnesia, falls, dependence, respiratory depression, and dangerous interactions with opioids or other sedatives can occur.

### **Triazole**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called triazole. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Triazophos**

A medical term referring to triazophos. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tributylin**

A medical term referring to tributyrin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

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### **T-Wave Alternans**

T-wave alternans is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Tympanic Bulla**

The tympanic bulla is a hollow or expanded bony chamber surrounding the middle ear, especially prominent in many mammals.

### **Tyrosinase Peptide**

tyrosinase peptide is a defined chemical or biologic substance involved in tyrosinase peptide and studied in physiology, pharmacology, laboratory medicine, or treatment.

### **TAPVR**

Alternate index label; see *Total anomalous pulmonary venous return (TAPVR)*.

### **TB**

Alternate index label; see *Tuberculosis*.

### **TBI**

Alternate index label; see *Traumatic brain injury*.

### **Tears, Decreased Production**

Alternate index label; see *Dry eyes*.

### **Teeth Grinding**

Alternate index label; see *Teeth grinding (bruxism)*.

### **Temporomandibular Disorders**

Alternate index label; see *TMJ disorders*.

### **Temporomandibular Joint Disorders**

Alternate index label; see *TMJ disorders*.

### **TEN**

Alternate index label; see *Toxic epidermal necrolysis*.

### **Tendinitis, Achilles**

Alternate index label; see *Achilles tendinitis*.

### **Tendinitis, Patellar**

Alternate index label; see *Patellar tendinitis*.

### **Tenosynovitis, De Quervain's**

Alternate index label; see *De Quervain tenosynovitis*.

### **Testicle, Retractable**

Alternate index label; see *Retractable testicle*.

### **Testicle, Undescended**

Alternate index label; see *Undescended testicle*.

### **Testosterone Deficiency**

Alternate index label; see *Male hypogonadism*.

### **TGA**

Alternate index label; see *Transient global amnesia*.

### **Three-Day Measles**

Alternate index label; see *Rubella*.

### **Thrush, Oral**

Alternate index label; see *Oral thrush*.

### **Thyroid Gland Enlargement**

Alternate index label; see *Goiter*.

### **Thyroid, Overactive**

Alternate index label; see *Hyperthyroidism (overactive thyroid)*.

### **Thyroiditis, Chronic Lymphocytic**

Alternate index label; see *Hashimoto's disease*.

### **Tinea Cruris**

Alternate index label; see *Jock itch*.

### **TMD**

Alternate index label; see *TMJ disorders*.

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### **TNBC**

Alternate index label; see *Triple-negative breast cancer (TNBC)*.

### **Toenail Fungus**

Alternate index label; see *Nail fungus*.

### **Tongue Tie**

Tongue tie concerns tongue tie, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Torsion, Testicular**

Alternate index label; see *Testicular torsion*.

### **Torticollis, Spasmodic**

Alternate index label; see *Cervical dystonia*.

### **Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Connection**

Alternate index label; see *Total anomalous pulmonary venous return (TAPVR)*.

### **Tourette's**

Alternate index label; see *Tourette syndrome*.

### **Transposition Of Great Vessels**

Alternate index label; see *Transposition of the great arteries*.

### **Traumatic Grief**

Alternate index label; see *Complicated grief*.

### **Trisomy 21 Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Down syndrome*.

### **Trisomy X**

Alternate index label; see *Triple X syndrome*.

### **Trouble Swallowing**

Alternate index label; see *Dysphagia*.

### **Trypanosomiasis, American**

Alternate index label; see *Chagas disease*.

### **Tumor, Salivary Gland**

Alternate index label; see *Salivary gland tumors*.

### **Tumor, Spinal**

Alternate index label; see *Spinal tumor and spinal mass*.

### **T-Cell Count**

T-cell count examines t-cell count; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **T3 Test**

T3 test examines t3 test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **T3RU Test**

T3RU test examines t3ru test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tailbone Trauma**

A biomedical term referring to tailbone trauma; its classification, distinguishing features, and medical significance depend on the clinical or biologic context.

### **Tailbone Trauma - Aftercare**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tailbone trauma - aftercare; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Talcum Powder Poisoning**

Talcum powder poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to talcum powder poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tapeworm Infection - Beef Or Pork**

Tapeworm infection - beef or pork examines tapeworm infection - beef or pork; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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### **Tapeworm Infection - Hymenolepis**

Tapeworm infection - hymenolepis examines tapeworm infection - hymenolepis; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tar Remover Poisoning**

Tar remover poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to tar remover poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tarantula Spider Bite**

Tarantula spider bite involves toxic or environmental exposure to tarantula spider bite; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Targeted Therapies For Cancer**

Targeted therapies for cancer involves toxic or environmental exposure to targeted therapies for cancer; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Targeted Therapy: Questions To Ask Your Doctor**

Targeted therapy: questions to ask your doctor involves toxic or environmental exposure to targeted therapy: questions to ask your doctor; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Taste - Impaired**

Taste - impaired is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Tay-Sachs - Resources**

Tay-Sachs - resources addresses care related to tay-sachs - resources, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **TBG Blood Test**

TBG blood test examines tbg blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Td (Tetanus, Diphtheria) Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to td (tetanus, diphtheria) vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tdap (Tetanus, Diphtheria And Pertussis) Vaccine - What You Need To Know**

A medical term referring to tdap (tetanus, diphtheria and pertussis) vaccine - what you need to know. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Teenagers And Drugs**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called teenagers and drugs. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Teenagers And Sleep**

Teenagers commonly need about eight to ten hours of sleep, but schedules, screens, caffeine, mood, school demands, and sleep disorders can reduce sleep quality.

### **Telangiectasia**

Telangiectasia examines telangiectasia; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Telehealth**

Delivery of healthcare through secure electronic communication or remote monitoring, including video visits, telephone care, messaging, and transmission of clinical data.

### **Temperature Measurement**

Measurement of body or environmental temperature using a thermometer or sensor at a specified site, interpreted with method, age, timing, and clinical

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context.

### **Tendon Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tendon repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tennis Elbow Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tennis elbow surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tennis Elbow Surgery - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tennis elbow surgery - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tensilon Test**

Tensilon test examines tensilon test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Testicle Lump**

Testicle lump examines testicle lump; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Testicle Pain**

Testicle pain examines testicle pain; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Testicular Biopsy**

Testicular biopsy examines testicular biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Testicular Self-Exam**

Testicular self-exam examines testicular self-exam; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Testicular Torsion Repair**

Testicular torsion repair examines testicular torsion repair; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tests And Visits Before Surgery**

Tests and visits before surgery examines tests and visits before surgery; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tests For H Pylori**

Tests for H pylori examines tests for h pylori; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tetrahydrozoline Poisoning**

Tetrahydrozoline poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to tetrahydrozoline poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **The Day Of Surgery For Your Child**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to the day of surgery for your child; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **The Day Of Your Surgery - Adult**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to the day of your surgery - adult; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **The Night Before Your Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to the night before your surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **The Night Before Your Surgery - Children**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to the night before your surgery - chil-

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dren; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Therapeutic Drug Levels**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called therapeutic drug levels. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Thiamin**

A medical term referring to thiamin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Thiazide Overdose**

Thiazide overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to thiazide overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Thioridazine Overdose**

Thioridazine overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to thioridazine overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Thirst - Absent**

Reduced or absent desire to drink despite a potential need for fluids, which can occur with hypothalamic disease, aging, altered consciousness, medications, or severe illness.

### **Thirst - Excessive**

Polydipsia, an abnormally strong or persistent desire to drink, commonly associated with dehydration, diabetes mellitus, diabetes insipidus, medicines, or psychiatric conditions.

### **Thoracic Spine CT Scan**

Thoracic spine CT scan examines thoracic spine ct scan; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Thoracic Spine X-Ray**

Thoracic spine x-ray examines thoracic spine x-ray;

interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Throat Or Larynx Cancer**

A neoplastic condition involving throat Or Larynx Cancer; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Throat Swab Culture**

Throat swab culture examines throat swab culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Thrombolytic Drugs For Heart Attack**

A pharmacologic agent associated with thrombolytic Drugs For Heart Attack; its mechanism, indications, interactions, contraindications, and adverse effects depend on the specific product.

### **Thrombolytic Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to thrombolytic therapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Thrush - Children And Adults**

Oral candidiasis caused by Candida overgrowth, producing removable white plaques, soreness, redness, altered taste, or cracks at the mouth corners; risk rises with antibiotics, inhaled steroids, diabetes, or immune suppression.

### **Thrush In Newborns**

Oral Candida infection in an infant, causing white plaques on the tongue or mouth lining that may interfere with feeding and can be passed between infant and breastfeeding parent.

### **Thyroid Cancer - Medullary Carcinoma**

A neoplastic condition involving thyroid Cancer - Medullary Carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.



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### **Thyroid Cancer - Papillary Carcinoma**

A neoplastic condition involving thyroid Cancer - Papillary Carcinoma; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Thyroid Gland Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to thyroid gland removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Thyroid Gland Removal - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to thyroid gland removal - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Thyroid Preparation Overdose**

Thyroid preparation overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to thyroid preparation overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tick Bite**

Tick bite involves toxic or environmental exposure to tick bite; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tick Removal**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tick removal; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Timing Of Breastfeeding**

The timing and frequency of breastfeeds, usually guided by early hunger cues and effective milk transfer rather than a rigid clock schedule, with special considerations for newborns and preterm infants.

### **TMJ Disorders**

A clinical finding or condition involving tMJ Disorders; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

**Synonyms:**

Temporomandibular Disorders Temporomandibular Joint Disorders TMD

### **Toddler Test Or Procedure Preparation**

Toddler test or procedure preparation examines toddler test or procedure preparation; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Toilet Bowl Cleaners And Deodorizers Poisoning**

Toilet bowl cleaners and deodorizers poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to toilet bowl cleaners and deodorizers poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tolmetin Overdose**

Tolmetin overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to tolmetin overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Toluene And Xylene Poisoning**

Toluene and xylene poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to toluene and xylene poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Tongue Biopsy**

Tongue biopsy examines tongue biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tongue Problems**

Tongue problems concerns tongue problems, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Tonsil And Adenoid Removal - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tonsil and adenoid removal - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

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## **Tonsil Removal - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Tonsil removal - what to ask your doctor examines tonsil removal - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Tonsillectomies And Children**

Tonsillectomies and children examines tonsillectomies and children; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Tooth - Abnormal Colors**

Abnormal tooth color can result from plaque, decay, trauma, fluorosis, medicines, enamel defects, or staining, and the cause determines treatment.

## **Tooth - Abnormal Shape**

Abnormal tooth shape may result from developmental defects, genetic conditions, trauma, wear, or tumors and can affect function, appearance, and eruption.

## **Tooth Abscess**

A tooth abscess is a localized collection of pus from bacterial infection of the tooth or surrounding tissues, causing pain, swelling, and possible spreading infection.

## **Tooth Anatomy**

Tooth anatomy includes enamel, dentin, pulp, cementum, root, crown, periodontal ligament, and supporting bone and gums.

## **Tooth Decay - Early Childhood**

Early-childhood tooth decay is bacterial acid destruction of primary teeth, promoted by frequent sugars, poor brushing, enamel defects, and prolonged bottle or nursing exposure.

## **Tooth Formation - Delayed Or Absent**

Delayed or absent tooth formation means teeth develop or erupt later than expected or fail to form, due to local, genetic, endocrine, nutritional, or sys-

temic causes.

## **Toothaches**

Toothache is pain arising from decay, pulp inflammation, abscess, gum disease, trauma, cracking, or referred facial pain and requires dental assessment if persistent.

## **Toothpaste Overdose**

Toothpaste overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to toothpaste overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

## **TORCH Screen**

Testing for selected congenital infections—classically Toxoplasma, Other infections, Rubella, Cytomegalovirus, and Herpes—when fetal or newborn findings suggest an in-utero infection; broad panels require careful interpretation.

## **Total Abdominal Colectomy**

Total abdominal colectomy examines total abdominal colectomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Total Cholesterol**

Total cholesterol is the combined cholesterol carried in major blood lipoproteins; cardiovascular risk is assessed with HDL, LDL, triglycerides, and other factors.

## **Total Colectomy Or Proctocolectomy - Discharge**

Total colectomy or proctocolectomy - discharge examines total colectomy or proctocolectomy - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## **Total Hip Joint Replacement - Revision**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to total hip joint replacement - revision; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on

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the specific intervention and patient.

### **Total Knee Joint Replacement - Revision**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to total knee joint replacement - revision; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Total Parenteral Nutrition - Infants**

Total parenteral nutrition - infants addresses care related to total parenteral nutrition - infants, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Total Proctocolectomy And Ileal-Anal Pouch**

Total proctocolectomy and ileal-anal pouch examines total proctocolectomy and ileal-anal pouch; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Total Proctocolectomy With Ileostomy**

Total proctocolectomy with ileostomy examines total proctocolectomy with ileostomy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Total Protein**

Total protein concerns total protein, a body structure, substance, or clinical concept whose meaning depends on location, function, and patient context.

### **Toxic Synovitis**

Toxic synovitis involves toxic or environmental exposure to toxic synovitis; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Toxicology Screen**

Toxicology screen involves toxic or environmental exposure to toxicology screen; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Toxoplasma Blood Test**

Toxoplasma blood test examines toxoplasma blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tracheal Rupture**

Tracheal rupture is a tear in the windpipe caused by trauma, instrumentation, surgery, or pressure and can produce air leakage, breathing difficulty, and life-threatening complications.

### **Tracheoesophageal Fistula And Esophageal Atresia Repair**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tracheoesophageal fistula and esophageal atresia repair; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tracheomalacia - Acquired**

Acquired tracheomalacia is weakening of the tracheal wall after injury, inflammation, compression, or prolonged ventilation, causing airway collapse and breathing symptoms.

### **Tracheomalacia - Congenital**

Congenital tracheomalacia is weakness of the infant tracheal cartilage causing dynamic airway collapse, noisy breathing, cough, or recurrent respiratory symptoms.

### **Tracheostomy Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tracheostomy care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tracheostomy Tube - Eating**

A medical term referring to tracheostomy tube - eating. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tracheostomy Tube - Speaking**

A medical term referring to tracheostomy tube -

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speaking. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transcatheter aortic valve replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Transcranial Doppler Ultrasound**

Transcranial Doppler ultrasound examines transcranial doppler ultrasound; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Transient Familial Hyperbilirubinemia**

Transient familial hyperbilirubinemia is inherited temporary elevation of bilirubin, often from reduced conjugation, causing episodic jaundice without major liver injury.

### **Transient Tachypnea - Newborn**

Temporary rapid breathing in a newborn caused by delayed clearance of fetal lung fluid, usually beginning soon after birth and improving within one to three days with supportive care.

### **Transillumination**

Transillumination examines transillumination; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Transjugular Intrahepatic Portosystemic Shunt (TIPS)**

Transjugular intrahepatic portosystemic shunt (TIPS) addresses care related to transjugular intrahepatic portosystemic shunt (tips), including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Transplant Services**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transplant services; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Transurethral Resection Of The Prostate - Discharge**

Transurethral resection of the prostate - discharge examines transurethral resection of the prostate - discharge; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Transvaginal Ultrasound**

Transvaginal ultrasound examines transvaginal ultrasound; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Traumatic Amputation**

Traumatic amputation is loss of a body part from injury and requires hemorrhage control, preservation of the amputated part when possible, urgent surgery, rehabilitation, and psychological support.

### **Traumatic Events And Children**

Traumatic events can affect children's safety, behavior, sleep, learning, and emotions; supportive caregivers, stable routines, and professional assessment help identify persistent trauma responses.

### **Traumatic Injury Of The Bladder And Urethra**

A clinical condition involving traumatic Injury Of The Bladder And Urethra; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Traveler's Diarrhea Diet**

Traveler's diarrhea diet addresses care related to traveler's diarrhea diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Traveler's Guide To Avoiding Infectious Diseases**

Traveler's guide to avoiding infectious diseases examines traveler's guide to avoiding infectious diseases; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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### **Trazodone Overdose**

Trazodone overdose involves toxic or environmental exposure to trazodone overdose; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Treatment For Childhood Cancer - Long-Term Risks**

A neoplastic condition involving treatment For Childhood Cancer - Long-Term Risks; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### **Tremor - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tremor - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Trench Mouth**

Trench mouth is acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis causing painful bleeding gums, foul breath, and ulceration, often associated with plaque, smoking, stress, or poor nutrition.

### **Trichorrhexis Nodosa**

A hair-shaft defect in which weakened points split into brush-like ends, caused by inherited disease, trauma, chemicals, heat, or nutritional or metabolic disorders.

### **Triglyceride Level**

Triglyceride level is a defined medical, biological, or research term; it describes the named process, measurement, structure, or finding and is interpreted with the surrounding clinical information.

### **Trisodium Phosphate Poisoning**

Trisodium phosphate poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to trisodium phosphate poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Trisomy 13**

Patau syndrome, a chromosomal disorder caused by

an extra chromosome 13 and associated with severe developmental, brain, facial, heart, kidney, and limb abnormalities.

### **Trisomy 18**

Edwards syndrome, a chromosomal disorder caused by an extra chromosome 18 and associated with growth restriction, characteristic craniofacial and limb findings, heart disease, and severe developmental impairment.

### **Troponin Test**

Troponin test examines troponin test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Trypsin And Chymotrypsin In Stool**

Trypsin and chymotrypsin in stool examines trypsin and chymotrypsin in stool; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Trypsinogen Test**

Trypsinogen test examines trypsinogen test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **TSH Test**

TSH test examines tsh test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **TSI Test**

TSI test examines tsi test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Tubal Ligation - Discharge**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to tubal ligation - discharge; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Tubal Ligation Reversal**

Microsurgical reconnection of previously divided or

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blocked fallopian-tube segments to restore a possible path for sperm and egg; success depends on remaining tube length, age, scarring, and original method.

### **Tularemia Blood Test**

Tularemia blood test examines tularemia blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Turbinate Surgery**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to turbinate surgery; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Turning Patients Over In Bed**

Repositioning a patient at planned intervals to protect skin, improve comfort and breathing, prevent pressure injuries and contractures, and reduce complications of immobility.

### **Turpentine Oil Poisoning**

Turpentine oil poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to turpentine oil poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### **Type 1 Diabetes**

Type 1 diabetes is autoimmune destruction of pancreatic beta cells causing absolute insulin deficiency, hyperglycemia, and risk of diabetic ketoacidosis without insulin replacement.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diabetes, Type 1 Diabetes Type 1 (Type 1 Diabetes)

### **Type 1 Diabetes - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to type 1 diabetes - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Type 2 Diabetes**

Type 2 diabetes is chronic hyperglycemia caused by

insulin resistance and progressive beta-cell dysfunction, with risks to the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, and blood vessels.

#### **Synonyms:**

Diabetes, Type 2 Diabetes Type 2 (Type 2 Diabetes)

### **Type 2 Diabetes - Oral Medicines**

Oral medicines for type 2 diabetes lower glucose through effects on insulin, liver glucose production, kidney reabsorption, or intestinal absorption; choice depends on health and treatment goals.

### **Type 2 Diabetes - Self-Care**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to type 2 diabetes - self-care; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Type 2 Diabetes - What To Ask Your Doctor**

Type 2 diabetes - what to ask your doctor examines type 2 diabetes - what to ask your doctor; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Type V Glycogen Storage Disease**

A clinical condition involving type V Glycogen Storage Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Types Of Chemotherapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to types of chemotherapy; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Types Of Health Care Providers**

Types of health care providers addresses care related to types of health care providers, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Types Of Hormone Therapy**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to types of hormone therapy; indica-



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tions, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

### **Types Of Ileostomy**

Types of ileostomy include end, loop, and continent procedures, which divert stool through an opening in the abdominal wall when the colon or rectum cannot be used normally.

### **Tachycardia Paroxysmal Atrial (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT))**

Alternate index label for Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT).

### **Tachycardia Paroxysmal Supraventricular (Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT))**

Alternate index label for Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia (PSVT).

### **TB (Tuberculosis (TB) Facts)**

Alternate index label for Tuberculosis (TB) Facts.

### **Teeth Grinding (Bruxism)**

Alternate index label for Bruxism.

### **Temporomandibular Joint Syndrome (TMJ)**

Alternate index label for TMJ.

### **Tendinitis Rotator Cuff (Rotator Cuff)**

Alternate index label for Rotator Cuff.

### **Tennis Elbow (Lateral Epicondylitis)**

Alternate index label for Lateral Epicondylitis.

### **Terms Medical Abbreviations (Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms)**

Alternate index label for Common Medical Abbreviations and Terms.

### **Testosterone Low (Low Testosterone (Low T))**

Alternate index label for Low Testosterone (Low

T).

### **Thallium**

Thallium is a toxic heavy metal that can cause gastrointestinal illness followed by painful peripheral neuropathy, hair loss, skin changes, kidney or liver injury, seizures, and cardiovascular or neurologic toxicity. Suspected exposure requires immediate poison-control or emergency guidance.

#### **Synonyms:**

Poisoning Thallium (Thallium)

### **Throat Cancer (Larynx Cancer)**

Alternate index label for Larynx Cancer.

### **Thrombocytopenia (Low Platelet Count)**

Alternate index label for Low Platelet Count.

### **Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children**

Thrush is Candida overgrowth in the mouth, producing white plaques, soreness, or feeding difficulty; Candida can also affect skin folds or diaper areas. Persistent, recurrent, severe, or immune-associated infection needs pediatric evaluation and appropriate antifungal treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Candida Infection Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children) Monilia Infection Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children) Oral Candidiasis Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children) Oral Moniliasis Children (Thrush And Other Yeast Infections In Children)

### **Thrush Contagious (Is Thrush Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Thrush Contagious.

### **Thymic Hyperplasia**

Thymic hyperplasia is enlargement of the thymus from increased lymphoid tissue or rebound growth and may be incidental. It can be associated with autoimmune disease, infection, endocrine conditions, or stress; imaging and clinical context distinguish it

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from a mass.

### **Thyroid Disease Symptoms And Signs**

Thyroid disease can cause symptoms of underactivity, overactivity, inflammation, nodules, or hormone excess, including fatigue, weight change, heat or cold intolerance, palpitations, bowel change, tremor, neck swelling, or menstrual disturbance. Blood testing guides evaluation.

### **Thyroid Nodules**

A thyroid nodule is a discrete growth within the thyroid and is often benign. Ultrasound, thyroid-function testing, and selected needle biopsy assess cancer risk; rapid growth, hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, or breathing problems needs prompt review.

#### **Synonyms:**

Nodule Thyroid (Thyroid Nodules)

### **TIA (Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA, Mini-Stroke))**

Alternate index label for Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA, Mini-Stroke).

### **Tic Douloureux (Trigeminal Neuralgia)**

Alternate index label for Trigeminal Neuralgia.

### **Ticks Bite (Ticks)**

Alternate index label for Ticks.

### **Tietze Syndrome (Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Costochondritis and Tietze Syndrome.

### **Tinea Pedis (Athlete's Foot)**

Alternate index label for Athlete's Foot.

### **Tinnitus (Ringing In The Ears)**

Alternate index label for Ringing in the Ears.

### **TMJ (Temporomandibular Joint Syndrome (TMJ))**

Alternate index label for Temporomandibular Joint

Syndrome (TMJ).

### **Tobacco Chewing (Smokeless Tobacco)**

Alternate index label for Smokeless Tobacco.

### **Toddlers Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

### **Toe Broken (Broken Toe)**

Alternate index label for Broken Toe.

### **Tonsil Inflammation (Adenoids And Tonsils)**

Alternate index label for Adenoids and Tonsils.

### **Tonsil Stones**

Tonsil stones are calcified collections of debris and bacteria in tonsil crypts, causing bad breath, throat irritation, or a foreign-body sensation. Gargling and oral hygiene may help; recurrent symptoms, bleeding, or one-sided enlargement requires examination.

### **Tooth Infected (Abscessed Tooth Guide)**

Alternate index label for Abscessed Tooth Guide.

### **Toothache Overview**

Toothache usually reflects decay, pulp inflammation, fracture, gum disease, abscess, trauma, or referred pain. Dental treatment is needed to correct the cause; facial swelling, fever, difficulty swallowing, or breathing difficulty requires urgent care.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain Tooth (Toothache Overview)

### **Torn ACL**

A torn anterior cruciate ligament is a knee injury commonly caused by sudden pivoting, landing, or contact, producing a pop, swelling, instability, and difficulty changing direction. Rehabilitation, bracing, or reconstruction is selected according to activity, associated injury, and goals.

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### **Torn Meniscus**

A torn meniscus is a split in the knee's shock-absorbing cartilage caused by twisting or degeneration. Pain, swelling, catching, or locking may occur; physical therapy or arthroscopic treatment depends on tear pattern, symptoms, age, and associated disease.

#### **Synonyms:**

Meniscus Tear

### **Torsion Testicle (Testicular Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Testicular Disorders.

### **TOS (Thoracic Outlet Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Thoracic Outlet Syndrome.

### **Toxic Shock Syndrome (TSS)**

Alternate index label for TSS.

### **Toxin Ciguatera (Ciguatera Poisoning)**

Alternate index label for Ciguatera Poisoning.

### **Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA, Mini-Stroke)**

Alternate index label for TIA, Mini-Stroke.

### **Trigger Thumb (Trigger Finger)**

Alternate index label for Trigger Finger.

### **Triggers IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention)**

Alternate index label for Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) Triggers, Prevention.

### **Trisomy 18 (Edwards Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Edwards Syndrome.

### **Trisomy 21 (Down Syndrome Overview)**

Alternate index label for Down Syndrome Overview.

### **Trochanteric Bursitis (Hip Bursitis)**

Alternate index label for Hip Bursitis.

### **TSS (Toxic Shock Syndrome (TSS))**

Alternate index label for Toxic Shock Syndrome (TSS).

### **Tuberculos Contagious (Is Tuberculosis (TB) Contagious)**

Alternate index label for Is Tuberculosis (TB) Contagious.

### **Tuberculosis (TB) Facts**

Alternate index label for TB) Fact.

### **Tubes Ear Problems (Eustachian Tube Problems)**

Alternate index label for Eustachian Tube Problems.

### **Tumor Adrenal Gland (Pheochromocytoma)**

Alternate index label for Pheochromocytoma.

### **Tumor Brain Cancer (Brain Cancer)**

Alternate index label for Brain Cancer.

### **Tumor Testicle (Testicular Disorders)**

Alternate index label for Testicular Disorders.

### **Tumors Uterine (Uterine Fibroids)**

Alternate index label for Uterine Fibroids.

### **Tweens Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

### **T Cell**

Abbreviation for T lymphocyte, a type of white blood cell that is produced in the bone marrow and is part of the body's immune system.

### **T.I.D. (On Prescription)**

T.I.D. means three times daily on a prescription; clear instructions should specify timing and should avoid ambiguous abbreviations when possible.

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### **T1-T12 (Thoracic Vertebrae)**

The twelve vertebrae of the chest region, each articulating with ribs and protecting the thoracic spinal cord while supporting the trunk and rib cage.

### **Tablet Splitting**

A medical term referring to tablet splitting. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Tache Noire**

Tache noire is a black eschar at the site of a tick bite, classically associated with Mediterranean spotted fever and related rickettsial infections.

### **Taint**

A taint is contamination or an undesirable influence; in medicine or laboratory work it may refer to contamination that affects a specimen, product, or result.

### **Talipes Equinovarus**

Clubfoot, a congenital deformity combining ankle equinus, hindfoot varus, forefoot adduction, and cavus; early serial casting and bracing are standard initial treatment.

### **Tamoxifen (Nolvadex)**

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to tamoxifen (nolvadex); its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Tap, Joint (Aspiration)**

Tap, joint (aspiration) refers to an anatomical structure, biological substance, or physiologic concept used in describing the human body and its function.

### **Taphephobia**

An excessive fear of being buried alive, classified as a specific phobia when it causes persistent distress, avoidance, or functional impairment.

### **Tarantism**

Tarantism is a historical term for a dancing or be-

havioral syndrome once attributed to spider bite and now understood as a cultural or neurologic phenomenon rather than a specific disease.

### **Targeted Radiation Therapy**

Targeted radiation therapy is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Tassinari Syndrome**

A clinical condition involving tassinari Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Tattoos & Permanent Makeup**

Tattoos and permanent makeup place pigment into the skin; risks include infection, allergy, scarring, blood-borne disease, and difficulty removing or changing the result.

### **TB Test**

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### **Td**

Td is a vaccine protecting against tetanus and diphtheria, generally used as a booster in adolescents and adults according to local schedules.

### **Td Immunization**

Vaccination against tetanus and reduced-dose diphtheria, used for routine boosters, catch-up immunization, and wound-related protection according to age and vaccination history.

### **Tear**

A split or rupture in tissue, such as a muscle, tendon, ligament, meniscus, skin, or organ, caused by trauma, overuse, degeneration, or pressure.

### **TEE**

TEE, or transesophageal echocardiography, uses an

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ultrasound probe in the esophagus to obtain detailed images of heart valves, chambers, clots, and nearby vessels.

### **Temporary Loss Of Consciousness**

Temporary loss of consciousness is a brief episode of unresponsiveness with loss of postural tone, commonly from syncope but sometimes from seizure or another disorder.

### **Tenia**

Tenia is an older or variant spelling related to Taenia, a genus of tapeworms that can infect humans or animals.

### **Tension**

A pulling force or state of being stretched; in medicine it may describe tissue tension, blood-vessel wall tension, muscle tightness, or psychological strain depending on context.

### **Ter In Die (On Prescription)**

Ter in die means three times a day on a prescription; explicit plain-language timing is safer than relying on Latin abbreviations.

### **Teratogenic**

Capable of causing congenital malformations, growth impairment, functional deficits, or pregnancy loss when an embryo or fetus is exposed during a vulnerable developmental period.

### **Teratogenic Drugs**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called teratogenic drugs. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Teratophobia**

An excessive fear of giving birth to a child with a congenital abnormality, classified as a specific phobia when persistent fear causes avoidance or impairment.

### **Terminal Ileitis**

Inflammation of the distal ileum, commonly associated with Crohn disease but also caused by infection, ischemia, medication, or other inflammatory conditions and producing pain, diarrhea, or bleeding.

### **Testicles**

The paired male reproductive glands in the scrotum that produce sperm and testosterone; pain, enlargement, a new lump, or sudden change requires examination.

### **Testicular Feminization Syndrome**

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### **Tetracycline**

A medicine, biologic, or pharmacologic term related to tetracycline; its mechanism, indication, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent.

### **Therapeutic**

Therapeutic means intended to treat, relieve, or manage a disease, symptom, impairment, or other health problem.

### **Therapeutic Cloning**

A medical term referring to therapeutic cloning. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Thermophobia**

An excessive or persistent fear of heat or high temperatures that causes avoidance, distress, or functional impairment.

### **Thermostat**

A thermostat regulates temperature by sensing heat and controlling a heating or cooling system; accurate environmental temperature can matter for patients, specimens, and medicines.

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### ThinPrep Pap Test

ThinPrep Pap test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### Thoracic

Thoracic means relating to the chest, the thoracic spine, or structures within the thorax such as the heart and lungs.

### Thorax

The thorax is the chest region between the neck and abdomen, enclosed by ribs and containing the heart, lungs, major vessels, and mediastinal structures.

### Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (TTP)

TTP is a life-threatening disorder in which severe ADAMTS13 deficiency causes platelet-rich microclots, low platelets, hemolytic anemia, neurologic or kidney injury, and fever.

### Thyrocalcitonin

A medical term referring to thyrocalcitonin. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Thyroid

A medical term referring to thyroid. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Thyroid Hormones

Thyroxine (T4) and triiodothyronine (T3), hormones that regulate metabolic rate, growth, brain development, heat production, and cardiovascular and gastrointestinal activity.

### Thyroid Peroxidase Test

Thyroid peroxidase test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### Tick Typhus

A medical term referring to tick typhus. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### Tilted Disc Syndrome

A clinical condition involving tilted Disc Syndrome; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### Tinea Unguium

A medical term referring to tinea unguium. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### TIPS

TIPS, or transjugular intrahepatic portosystemic shunt, connects portal and hepatic veins to reduce portal hypertension, often for variceal bleeding or refractory ascites.

### Tired

Feeling a lack of energy or physical or mental stamina, which may result from sleep loss, exertion, infection, anemia, endocrine disease, medication, depression, or other illness.

### Tiredness

Fatigue or reduced energy and endurance that can be physical, mental, or both; persistent unexplained fatigue warrants assessment for sleep, mood, systemic, medication, and metabolic causes.

### TMR

TMR is a context-dependent abbreviation, including targeted muscle reinnervation, a surgical technique used to improve control of a prosthesis and reduce amputation pain.

### Toc- (Prefix)

Toc- is a prefix used in some medical terms and often relates to childbirth or labor, as in tocolysis; the complete word determines its meaning.

### Toco-

The term Toco- is a medical word element or pre-



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fix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Toddler**

A toddler is a young child, usually about one to three years old, developing rapidly in movement, language, behavior, feeding, and independence.

### **Toenail**

A toenail is the hard keratin plate covering the end of a toe and protecting its underlying tissue; injury, fungus, and ingrowth can cause disease.

### **Toilet**

A medical term referring to toilet. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Toko- (Prefix)**

Toko- is a prefix relating to childbirth or labor, derived from Greek terms for birth.

### **Tom-**

The term Tom- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Tomo-**

The term Tomo- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Tomogram**

A tomogram is an image of a selected cross-sectional layer of the body or another object, produced by tomography such as CT or MRI.

### **Topoisomerase**

A medical term referring to topoisomerase. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **Total Knee Replacement**

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to total knee replacement; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific

intervention and patient.

### **Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis (TEN)**

Toxic epidermal necrolysis is a life-threatening severe skin reaction, usually to a medicine, causing widespread epidermal death and skin detachment with mucosal injury.

### **Toxicity**

Toxicity refers to harmful exposure to the named substance or condition; severity depends on dose, route, timing, symptoms, and patient factors, and urgent professional assessment may be required.

### **Toxoplasmosis (Toxo)**

A medical term referring to toxoplasmosis (toxoplasma). Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

### **TPN**

TPN, or total parenteral nutrition, supplies nutrients intravenously when the gastrointestinal tract cannot be used adequately.

### **Trachelectomy**

Trachelectomy is surgical removal of the cervix, sometimes with nearby tissue, used in selected cervical cancers or other conditions.

### **Trait**

A trait is a measurable characteristic of an organism influenced by genes, environment, development, or their interaction.

### **Trans- (Prefix)**

The term Trans- (prefix) is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

### **Transaminase, Serum Glutamic Pyruvic (SGPT)**

SGPT, now called ALT, is a liver-associated enzyme measured in blood and often elevated when liver cells are injured.

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## Transplantation Genetics

A medical procedure, treatment, device, or care topic related to transplantation genetics; indications, benefits, risks, and follow-up depend on the specific intervention and patient.

## Treacle

Treacle is a thick sugar syrup; in older medical usage, related terms referred to antidotes or mixtures, so context matters.

## Trich- (Prefix)

The term Trich- (prefix) is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

## Tricho- (Prefix)

The term Tricho- (prefix) is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

## Trigger

A trigger is an event, exposure, stimulus, or condition that initiates or worsens a symptom, disease episode, behavior, or physiologic response.

## Triglycerides

Triglycerides are blood fats made of glycerol and three fatty acids; elevated levels contribute to cardiovascular risk and, when very high, pancreatitis risk.

## Trip

A trip is a journey or an accidental stumble; in drug-related language it can also mean an episode of altered perception after a hallucinogen.

## Triptans (Triptan)

Triptans are serotonin-receptor agonists used to abort migraine attacks by constricting cranial vessels and reducing trigeminal signaling.

## Troche

A troche is a small medicated lozenge that dissolves slowly in the mouth or throat for local or systemic

drug delivery.

## Tropical Oil

A clinical finding or condition involving tropical Oil; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

## Trp

Trp is the standard abbreviation for tryptophan, an essential amino acid used in protein synthesis and serotonin and niacin pathways.

## Truncation

A shortened or incomplete form caused by removal of part of a sequence, structure, chromosome, protein, or process; the effect depends on what was lost and where.

## Trypophobia

An aversion or intense discomfort triggered by clustered holes or repetitive small patterns; it is clinically relevant only when persistent distress or avoidance causes impairment.

## TSD

TSD is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean total sleep deprivation, traumatic stress disorder, or another clinical term; the full term should be specified.

## TSE

TSE is a context-dependent abbreviation, including transmissible spongiform encephalopathy, the prion-disease group that includes Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease.

## TTP (Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura)

TTP is a medical emergency caused by platelet-rich microthrombi, usually from severe ADAMTS13 deficiency, producing low platelets, hemolytic anemia, and organ injury.

## Tubal Occlusion Procedure, Selective

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## **(STOP)**

Selective tubal occlusion blocks a fallopian tube to prevent sperm and egg from meeting and is a permanent contraceptive procedure.

## **Tube**

A medical term referring to tube. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Tuber**

A medical term referring to tuber. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Tuberculosis, MDR**

A clinical finding or condition involving tuberculosis, MDR; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

## **Tubes**

A medical term referring to tubes. Its clinical meaning depends on the context in which it is used.

## **Tumor Marker, CEA**

A neoplastic condition involving tumor Marker, CEA; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Tumor Marker, NSE**

A neoplastic condition involving tumor Marker, NSE; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

## **Tunnel Vision**

Loss of peripheral visual field leaving a narrowed central field, caused by glaucoma, retinal disease, optic-nerve or brain lesions, severe hypoxia, or other conditions.

## **Turmeric**

Turmeric is a plant spice containing curcuminoids and used in foods and supplements; evidence varies by condition and interactions or liver injury are possible.

## **TVS**

TVS commonly means transvaginal sonography, an ultrasound examination using a probe in the vagina to assess pelvic organs and early pregnancy.

## **Twilight Sleep**

Twilight sleep is an older term for a sedated, partly conscious state used during procedures; modern analgesia and anesthesia specify the medicines and monitoring used.

## **Twin**

A twin is one of two offspring from the same pregnancy, either identical from one fertilized egg or fraternal from two eggs and two sperm.

## **Twitch**

A brief involuntary muscle contraction or movement, which may be benign, medication-related, stress-related, or a sign of nerve, muscle, or brain disease.

## **Twitching**

Repeated involuntary muscle contractions or fasciculations, commonly caused by fatigue, stimulants, electrolyte disturbance, nerve irritation, medicines, or neurologic disease.

## **Tympanic**

Tympanic means relating to the eardrum or middle ear, or resembling a drum in shape or sound.

## **Tympano-**

The term Tympano- is a medical word element or prefix whose precise meaning depends on the word or clinical context in which it is used.

## **Tympany**

Tympany is a drumlike sound on percussion, often produced by gas in a hollow organ such as the stomach or intestine.

## **Type 3B Diabetes**

Type 3b diabetes is a form of diabetes caused by disease or removal of the pancreas, which can impair both insulin and digestive-enzyme production.

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## Therapeutic Abortion

Intentional termination of a pregnancy because of medical, fetal, or other legally recognized indications, according to applicable law and clinical guidance.

## Transient Global Amnesia

A temporary episode of sudden inability to form new memories, with repetitive questioning, that usually resolves within 24 hours.

### Synonyms:

TGA

## Thumb Arthritis

Degeneration or inflammation of a thumb joint, especially the joint at the base of the thumb, causing pain, stiffness, and reduced grip.

### Synonyms:

Basal Joint Arthritis

## Type 1 Diabetes In Children

Type 1 diabetes diagnosed during childhood, causing high blood sugar and requiring insulin, monitoring, nutrition planning, and education.

### Synonyms:

Diabetes, Type 1 In Children

## Type 2 Diabetes In Children

Type 2 diabetes beginning during childhood or adolescence, often involving insulin resistance and requiring lifestyle and medical management.

### Synonyms:

Diabetes, Type 2 In Children

## Threatened Miscarriage

Vaginal bleeding during early pregnancy with a closed cervix and no passage of pregnancy tissue; the pregnancy may remain viable. Evaluation commonly includes clinical assessment, serial human chorionic gonadotropin testing when indicated, and ultrasound.

### Synonyms:

Threatened abortion.

## Toe Joint

Any joint connecting the bones of a toe. Toe joints include the metatarsophalangeal and interphalangeal joints; they permit toe movement and may be affected by arthritis, gout, injury, or deformity.

### Synonyms:

toe articulation.

## Tail

A tapering appendage extending from the end of an animal's body. In human anatomy, the term may refer to a tail-like congenital structure or the embryologic caudal end; evaluation depends on the specific finding.

## Target Population

The defined group of people for whom a medical intervention, screening program, or research study is intended. It is characterized by criteria such as age, diagnosis, risk, or other relevant features.

## Total Artificial Heart

A mechanical device that replaces the pumping function of both ventricles and is used in selected patients with severe biventricular heart failure, usually as a bridge to transplantation. It requires specialized center-based management and carries risks including bleeding, infection, thrombosis, and device malfunction.

## Tender

Painful or sensitive when touched or pressed, a finding that may indicate inflammation, infection, trauma, ischemia, or another underlying process.

## TSH

Thyroid-stimulating hormone, a pituitary hormone that stimulates the thyroid gland to produce and release thyroid hormones. TSH is commonly measured with free T4 to evaluate thyroid function and monitor thyroid treatment.

## Tumor Necrosis Factor Receptor-Associated Periodic Syndrome

A rare inherited autoinflammatory disorder caused

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by variants in the TNFRSF1A gene, producing recurrent prolonged fever, muscle pain, abdominal pain, rash, and inflammation; it is also called TRAPS.

### **Total Sleep Time**

The total amount of time spent asleep during a defined sleep period or sleep study, excluding periods of wakefulness.

### **Tissue Expansion**

Gradual stretching of skin or soft tissue with an implanted or external expander so additional tissue can be created for reconstruction; it usually requires staged treatment and monitoring for infection, pain, or device problems.

### **Trichoblastoma**

A rare benign follicular tumor of the scalp or face, usually presenting as a solitary dermal or subcutaneous nodule; it can resemble basal-cell carcinoma and is diagnosed histologically.

### **Trichilemmoma**

A benign follicular tumor with outer-root-sheath differentiation, usually presenting as a small facial papule; multiple lesions may be associated with Cowden syndrome.

### **Trichilemmal Carcinoma**

A rare malignant follicular tumor showing outer-root-sheath differentiation, usually occurring on sun-damaged skin of older adults as a papule or nodule; complete excision is generally required.

### **Tubo-Ovarian Abscess**

A complex infected mass involving the fallopian tube and ovary, usually arising as a complication of pelvic inflammatory disease. It may cause pelvic pain, fever, and sepsis and requires prompt antimicrobial and sometimes drainage treatment.

### **Twin Placenta**

Placental anatomy in a twin pregnancy, classified by chorionicity and amnionicity; these features de-

termine risks such as twin-to-twin transfusion and guide antenatal monitoring.

### **Epithelioid Trophoblastic Tumor**

A rare gestational trophoblastic neoplasm composed of chorionic-type intermediate trophoblast, often arising months or years after a pregnancy and requiring specialist oncologic management.





## U

### Urinary

Relating to urine or to the organs and processes involved in producing and eliminating urine.

### Urine

The liquid waste produced by the kidneys, containing water and dissolved substances eliminated from the blood.

### U Wave

A small deflection following the T wave, best seen in precordial leads V2-V3. U waves are thought to represent repolarization of the Purkinje fibers or papillary muscles. Prominent U waves are associated with hypokalemia, bradycardia, and certain drugs (digitalis, quinidine).

### Unopposed Estrogen

Estrogen therapy given without a progestogen in a person with a uterus.

### Unresolved Losses

Significant losses that have not been fully acknowledged or emotionally processed.

### Upper Airway Resistance Syndrome

Increased effort to breathe through a narrowed upper airway, often causing sleep disruption and daytime sleepiness.

#### Synonyms:

UARS

### Upper Esophageal Sphincter

A muscular valve at the top of the esophagus that opens during swallowing.

#### Synonyms:

UES

### Urethral Hypermobility

Excessive movement of the urethra during increased abdominal pressure, contributing to stress incontinence.

### Urinary Tract

The kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra, which produce, transport, store, and excrete urine.

### Urologist

A physician specializing in urinary-tract disorders and the male reproductive system.

### Uvulopalatopharyngoplasty

Surgery that removes or reshapes the uvula, tonsils, and soft-palate tissue to treat obstructive sleep apnea.

#### Synonyms:

UPPP

### Ulcer, Aphthous

Alternate index label; see *Canker sore*.

### Ulcer, Peptic

Alternate index label; see *Peptic ulcer*.

### Ulcer, Rectal

Alternate index label; see *Solitary rectal ulcer syndrome*.

### Ulnar-Sided Wrist Pain

Alternate index label; see *Ulnar wrist pain*.

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## Ubiquinone

A lipid-soluble electron carrier in the mitochondrial membrane. See Coenzyme Q.

## Uhl Anomaly

A rare congenital absence or severe deficiency of right-ventricular myocardium, leaving a thin-walled right ventricle. It may cause right-sided heart failure, arrhythmia, cyanosis, or sudden deterioration in infancy or childhood.

## Ulcer

Full-thickness loss of epidermis extending into the dermis or deeper tissue, often healing with a scar. Causes include vascular disease, pressure, infection, neuropathy, inflammatory disease, trauma, and malignancy.

## Ulcer (Vascular)

A persistent break in the skin caused or maintained by inadequate blood flow, venous hypertension, neuropathy, or related vascular disease.

### Synonyms:

Vascular

## Ulcerative Colitis

A chronic inflammatory disease of the colon and rectum, usually causing continuous mucosal inflammation that begins in the rectum and extends proximally. Symptoms may include bloody diarrhea, urgency, abdominal pain, and extraintestinal manifestations.

### Synonyms:

Colitis, Ulcerative Colitis Ulcerative (Ulcerative Colitis)

## Ulna

Medial forearm bone, longer than the radius. Proximal end: trochlear notch, olecranon, coronoid process. Shaft. Distal end: head, styloid process. The trochlear notch articulates with the trochlea forming the primary elbow hinge.

## Ulnar

Relating to the ulna bone of the forearm or the

ulnar side (medial side) of the hand. Ulnar nerve compression causes paresthesia in medial one and a half fingers.

## Ulnar Artery

The larger terminal branch of the brachial artery at the cubital fossa, running medially down the forearm to the wrist (palpable medial to the pisiform) and hand. Supplies the medial forearm and ulnar side of the hand; forms the superficial palmar arch. Provides the common interosseous artery.

## Ulnar Hypoplasia

Underdevelopment or partial absence of the ulna, usually presenting as a congenital forearm and hand anomaly. It may cause forearm shortening, radial deviation of the hand, limited elbow or wrist movement, and associated digital or systemic abnormalities.

## Ulnar Nerve

From medial cord (C8-T1), passing behind the medial epicondyle (cubital tunnel), into the forearm innervating flexor carpi ulnaris and medial FDP half. In the hand innervates hypothenar muscles, interossei, medial two lumbricals, and adductor pollicis. Sensation to medial 1.5 digits.

## Ulnar Nerve Dysfunction

Impairment of the ulnar nerve, commonly caused by compression at the elbow (cubital tunnel) or wrist (Guyon canal). Symptoms include numbness or tingling in the little and ring fingers, weakened grip, and hand-muscle wasting; severe lesions may produce an ulnar claw.

## Ultrasonography

Imaging that uses high-frequency sound waves to produce pictures of tissues and organs.

## Ultrasound

Ultrasound uses high-frequency sound waves to create images of organs, vessels, tissues, or a developing fetus without ionizing radiation. quadrant (RUQ): gallbladder (gallstones, cholecystitis), liver (steatosis, cysts), kidneys, and pancreas. Pelvic:

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uterus, ovaries, adnexa. Renal: hydronephrosis, stones, cysts, tumors. Scrotal: testicular torsion, epididymitis, varicocele, hydrocele.

### **Ultrasound Contrast**

A substance administered during ultrasound to increase the visibility of blood flow or selected tissues.

### **Ultrasound Therapy**

Therapeutic ultrasound for tissue healing, pain, scar tissue.

### **Ultrasound Transducer**

A device that emits and receives high-frequency sound waves to generate diagnostic images or guide procedures. Linear, curvilinear, phased-array, and endocavitary transducers are selected according to depth and anatomic application.

### **Umbilical Artery Doppler**

Ultrasound assessment of blood flow in the umbilical arteries to evaluate placental resistance. Normal flow shows a pulsatility index decreasing throughout pregnancy with forward diastolic flow. Absent or reversed end-diastolic flow indicates severe placental dysfunction and is associated with increased perinatal morbidity and mortality.

### **Umbilical Cord**

The connection between the fetus and the placenta, containing two umbilical arteries (carrying deoxygenated blood from the fetus to the placenta) and one umbilical vein (carrying oxygenated blood from the placenta to the fetus). The vessels are embedded in Wharton jelly, a mucopolysaccharide matrix that prevents compression.

### **Umbilical Cord Blood Gas**

Analysis of arterial and venous cord blood collected after delivery. The umbilical artery best reflects fetal acid-base status, while the umbilical vein reflects placental blood. Results are interpreted using gestational age, delivery circumstances, pH, carbon dioxide, and base deficit or excess.

### **Umbilical Cord Prolapse**

Descent of the umbilical cord through the cervix alongside or past the presenting fetal part, occurring when the membranes rupture. Risk factors: malpresentation (transverse lie, breech), preterm/low birth weight, polyhydramnios, multiparity, and artificial ROM with high presenting part.

### **Umbilical Hernia**

A hernia through the umbilical ring, common in infants (most umbilical hernias close spontaneously by age 4-5) and adults (risk factors: obesity, pregnancy, ascites, cirrhosis). Presents as a reducible bulge at the umbilicus, worse with increased intra-abdominal pressure. In adults: risk of incarceration and strangulation is higher.

### **Umbilical Region**

Central region around the umbilicus containing small intestine, transverse colon, and great vessels. The umbilicus is a landmark for assessing ascites, caput medusae in portal hypertension, and umbilical hernias. Percussion and auscultation here are essential components of the abdominal examination.

### **Umbilication**

Formation of a central depression or navel-like indentation in a lesion or structure.

### **Umbilicus (Navel)**

The scar on the anterior abdominal wall marking the site of attachment of the umbilical cord in fetal life, located at the level of the L3-L4 intervertebral disc, approximately midway between the xiphoid process and the pubic symphysis.

#### **Synonyms:**

Navel

### **Uncompetitive Inhibition**

A type of enzyme inhibition where the inhibitor binds only to the enzyme-substrate (ES) complex at a site distinct from the active site, forming an inactive ESI complex. The inhibitor cannot bind to the free enzyme.

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## Unconsciousness

Loss of awareness and responsiveness, ranging from brief fainting to prolonged coma.

## Underweight

BMI < 18.5 kg/m<sup>2</sup>. Associated with osteoporosis, infertility, anemia, weakened immunity, surgical complications. Causes: hypermetabolism, malabsorption, eating disorders, malignancy, chronic infection.

## Undescended Testis

Failure of one or both testes to descend into the scrotum. Some descend during early infancy, but persistent cryptorchidism can impair fertility and increase the risk of torsion, hernia, or testicular cancer.

## Undescended Testis (Cryptorchidism)

Congenital failure of one or both testes to descend along the normal path into the scrotum. Persistent cases require evaluation because they may affect fertility and increase the risk of torsion, hernia, or testicular cancer.

### Synonyms:

Cryptorchidism

## Undulant Fever

A zoonotic infectious disease caused by gram-negative coccobacilli of the genus *Brucella*, transmitted to humans through contact with infected animals (cattle, goats, pigs, sheep) or consumption of unpasteurized dairy products. See Brucellosis.

## Unguentum

A semisolid, greasy preparation intended for application to the skin or, when formulated for that purpose, to mucous membranes or the eyes.

## Uniparental Disomy

Inheritance of both copies of a chromosome or chromosome segment from one parent and none from the other. It can cause disease through abnormal genomic imprinting, homozygosity for a recessive variant, or chromosomal dosage effects.

## Unresponsive Coma

A state of profound unresponsiveness in which the person cannot be awakened or follow commands.

## Unstable Angina

Myocardial ischemia at rest, new-onset severe angina, or a crescendo pattern (more frequent, longer, lower-threshold) without evidence of myocardial necrosis (normal troponin). Pathophysiology: acute plaque rupture with thrombosis causing transient severe coronary obstruction.

## Upper Airway Obstruction

Narrowing of the airway above the carina, causing inspiratory stridor, dyspnea, and characteristic changes on flow-volume loops (flattening of the inspiratory limb). Causes include tumors, stenosis, goiter, and vocal cord dysfunction. It is a medical emergency when severe.

## Upper Endoscopy

Upper endoscopy: flexible endoscopic examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum. See Esophagogastroduodenoscopy (EGD).

## Upper Extremity Venous Doppler

An ultrasound examination of the arm and related veins that assesses compressibility and blood flow, commonly to evaluate suspected venous thrombosis.

## Upper Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Bleeding from esophagus, stomach, or duodenum. Causes: peptic ulcer, varices, Mallory-Weiss tear, gastritis. Presentation: hematemesis, melena, hematochezia. Management: ABCs, IV access, type and crossmatch, PPI infusion, endoscopy within 24 hours. Variceal bleeding: octreotide, antibiotics, band ligation.

## Upper GI Series

Fluoroscopic examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum after oral barium contrast. Single-contrast: looks for gross abnormalities (obstruction, masses). Double-contrast (barium + gas): better mucosal detail for ulcers, erosions, and early malignancies.

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## Upper Motor Neuron Syndrome

A pattern caused by injury to corticospinal pathways above the anterior horn cell or cranial motor nucleus. Findings may include weakness with spasticity, hyperreflexia, clonus, and an extensor plantar response, although acute lesions can initially produce flaccidity.

## Upright Labor Positions

Maternal positions during labor, such as walking, standing, squatting, kneeling, or sitting upright. They may improve comfort and mobility and can be used when safe and acceptable to the laboring person and clinical team.

## Uptake

Cellular accumulation of radiotracer. Depends on blood flow, membrane transport, metabolism, binding.

## Urachal Cyst

A cystic remnant of the embryonic urachus between the bladder and umbilicus. It may be asymptomatic or become infected, causing lower-abdominal pain, fever, umbilical discharge, or urinary symptoms.

## Urachal Mucinous Cystic Tumor

A rare tumor arising from the urachal remnant between the bladder dome and umbilicus. It may be benign or malignant, with mucinous histology, and requires surgical excision.

## Uraemia

The clinical syndrome resulting from accumulation of urea and other nitrogenous waste products in the blood in advanced chronic kidney disease (CKD stage 4-5) and acute kidney injury.

## Urate-Lowering Therapy

Long-term treatment that reduces serum urate to dissolve monosodium urate deposits and prevent gout flares and structural damage. Xanthine oxidase inhibitors and uricosuric medicines are selected according to renal function, comorbidity, and treatment goals.

## Urea Cycle

A metabolic pathway occurring in both the mitochondria and cytoplasm of hepatocytes that converts toxic ammonia ( $\text{NH}_3$ ), derived from amino acid catabolism, into nontoxic, water-soluble urea for excretion by the kidneys.

## Urea Cycle Disorder

A group of inherited disorders caused by deficiency of an enzyme or transporter in the urea cycle, leading to impaired ammonia clearance. Ornithine transcarbamylase deficiency is an X-linked form; presentation and severity vary by the gene and residual enzyme activity.

## Uremia

A clinical syndrome caused by advanced kidney failure and accumulation of waste products and other biologically active substances. Symptoms may include nausea, itching, fatigue, confusion, bleeding, or pericarditis; laboratory values and symptoms must be interpreted together.

## Uremic Encephalopathy

Neurological syndrome in severe renal failure. Confusion, asterixis, seizures, coma. Results from uremic toxin accumulation. Diagnosis is clinical in context of advanced renal failure. Emergent dialysis indicated with rapid neurological improvement typically.

## Uremic Frost

Urea crystallization on skin in severe untreated uremia. Rare finding indicating extremely advanced uremia. White crystalline deposits on skin. Indicates immediate need for dialysis. Extremely rare in developed countries due to early detection.

## Uremic Pericarditis

Pericardial inflammation in advanced uremia. Pleuritic chest pain, friction rub, diffuse ST elevation. Indicates need for emergent dialysis. Does not respond to anti-inflammatory therapy. Complications include tamponade.

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## Uremic Platelet Dysfunction

Impaired platelet adhesion and aggregation in uremia causing bleeding tendency. Easy bruising, epistaxis, GI bleeding. Improves with dialysis and desmopressin. Cryoprecipitate provides temporary benefit before procedures.

## Uremic Stomatitis

Oral mucosal inflammation occurring in advanced kidney failure, presenting as white plaques, ulceration, or bleeding of the gums and tongue due to accumulation of uremic toxins.

## Ureter

The paired muscular tubes (25-30 cm) conveying urine from the renal pelvis to the urinary bladder, crossing the pelvic brim at the pelvic inlet. Three anatomical narrowings (pelviureteric junction, pelvic brim, vesicoureteric junction) are common sites of ureteric stone impaction.

## Ureter Duplex

A congenital duplication of the ureter, complete or partial, draining one kidney. It may be asymptomatic or associated with vesicoureteral reflux, ureterocele, obstruction, recurrent urinary infection, or impaired renal drainage.

## Ureteral Obstruction

Blockage of urine flow causing proximal dilation and increased pressure. Acute causes renal colic with flank pain. Chronic leads to hydronephrosis and CKD. Emergent decompression with stent or nephrostomy for infected obstructed kidney. Diagnosis by CT or ultrasound showing hydronephrosis.

### Synonyms:

Blocked Ureter

## Ureteral Perforation

A tear or hole in the ureter, sometimes caused by a stone, trauma, surgery, or an endoscopic procedure. Urine may leak into surrounding tissues, causing pain, infection, or inflammation; prompt imaging and urologic assessment are required.

## Ureteral Stent

Double-J stent maintaining ureteral patency. Indications: obstruction (stone, stricture, malignancy), post-ureteroscopy. Materials: silicone, polyurethane. Sizes: 4.7-7 Fr, lengths 24-30 cm. Complications: irritation, hematuria, encrustation, migration.

## Ureteral Stent (Double-J Stent)

A tube placed in the ureter from the renal pelvis to the bladder to maintain patency, with pigtail coils at both ends (hence double-J). Indications: ureteral obstruction (stones, stricture, malignancy), after ureteroscopy (prevent post-op obstruction), and as a pre-treatment for complex ureteral stones.

### Synonyms:

Double-J Stent

## Ureteral Stricture

Narrowing of the ureter caused by fibrosis, surgery, instrumentation, radiation, infection, malignancy, or congenital disease. It can produce upstream hydronephrosis, pain, infection, and declining renal function.

## Ureteritis

Inflammation of the ureter, usually related to infection, obstruction, stone passage, instrumentation, or adjacent inflammatory disease. It may cause flank or abdominal pain, urinary symptoms, hematuria, and fever.

## Ureterocele

A ureterocele is a balloon-like dilation of the lower ureter as it enters the bladder, usually congenital; it can obstruct urine flow and cause infection, hydronephrosis, reflux, stones, or impaired renal function. can obstruct urine flow and cause urinary infection, hydronephrosis, reflux, stone formation, or impaired renal function.

## Ureterolithiasis

The presence of kidney stones (calculi) within the ureter, causing ureteral obstruction and renal colic. Stones form from calcium oxalate/phosphate (most), uric acid, struvite (infection), and cystine.



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## Ureteropelvic Junction Obstruction

Impaired drainage from the renal pelvis into the proximal ureter, caused by intrinsic narrowing, aberrant vessels, scarring, or functional peristaltic abnormality. It may cause hydronephrosis, flank pain, infection, stones, or loss of renal function.

## Ureteroscopy

Ureteroscopy uses a small endoscope passed through the urinary tract to inspect, biopsy, or treat ureteral or kidney stones and other lesions. the urethra, bladder, and into the ureter or renal collecting system. Used primarily for the diagnostic evaluation and therapeutic management of ureteral and renal calculi, ureteral strictures, and upper tract urothelial carcinoma (UTUC).

## Urethra

The tube conveying urine from the bladder to the exterior. Male urethra (18-20 cm): prostatic, membranous, and spongy (penile) parts; carries urine and semen; longer and more tortuous than female. Female urethra (3-4 cm): short, straight, predisposing to ascending urinary tract infections.

## Urethracele

A herniation or prolapse of the urethra into the anterior vaginal wall, often occurring together with a cystocele (bladder prolapse). Urethracele is caused by weakening of the pubocervical fascia, often from childbirth, aging, or increased intra-abdominal pressure.

## Urethral Diverticulum

A periurethral outpouching that communicates with the urethral lumen, usually arising from infected or obstructed periurethral glands. It may cause dysuria, post-void dribbling, recurrent urinary infection, dyspareunia, or a palpable anterior-vaginal-wall mass.

## Urethral Infection

Infection involving the urethra, commonly caused by bacteria, including sexually transmitted organisms. Symptoms may include burning urination, discharge, frequency, or pelvic discomfort; testing

and appropriate treatment help prevent complications and transmission.

## Urethral Meatus

External opening of urethra. Position abnormal in hypospadias, epispadias.

## Urethral Pressure Profile

Measurement of urethral closure pressure along urethra. Used in incontinence evaluation.

## Urethral Pressures

Measurements of pressure within or along the urethra used to assess urethral closure and urinary continence.

## Urethral Sling

Synthetic or fascial tape supporting urethra for stress incontinence. Mid-urethral sling (TVT, TOT) standard. Minimally invasive. Complications: erosion, urgency, retention.

## Urethral Stricture

Narrowing of the urethra caused by scar tissue. It may produce a weak urinary stream, spraying, straining, incomplete emptying, infections, or urinary retention and can result from injury, instrumentation, infection, or inflammatory disease.

## Urethritis

Urethritis is inflammation of the urethra, commonly from sexually transmitted infection, causing dysuria, irritation, or discharge and requiring evaluation of partners and complications. (Chlamydia trachomatis, Neisseria gonorrhoeae) or non-infectious causes. Presents with dysuria, urethral discharge, and meatal itching. Diagnosis: urine nucleic acid amplification testing (NAAT).

## Urethrography

Contrast imaging of urethra. Evaluates urethral strictures, trauma, anomalies.

## Urge Urinary Incontinence

Involuntary leakage of urine, significantly affecting

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psychological, social, and physical well-being. See urinary incontinence.

### **Urgency**

A sudden, compelling desire to urinate that is difficult to defer—a lower urinary tract symptom. Causes: overactive bladder (detrusor overactivity, often idiopathic), urinary tract infection (urgency + dysuria), bladder outlet obstruction (BPH), neurogenic bladder, interstitial cystitis, and pelvic floor disorders.

### **Uric Acid Nephropathy**

Acute kidney injury from uric acid crystal precipitation in tubules. Occurs in tumor lysis syndrome and severe hyperuricemia. Prevent with hydration and rasburicase. Alkalinization of urine may be harmful as uric acid precipitates at alkaline pH unlike other stone types.

### **Uric Acid Stones**

Kidney stones composed primarily of uric acid. They form more readily in acidic urine and are associated with hyperuricemia, gout, high purine intake, or chronic diarrhea. Some can dissolve when urine is alkalinized.

### **Urinal**

Male bedside container.

### **Urinalysis**

Urinalysis examines urine appearance, chemistry, and sediment for evidence of infection, kidney disease, bleeding, diabetes, dehydration, or other systemic conditions. (bacteria), protein, glucose, ketones, bilirubin, urobilinogen, blood, and hemoglobin.

### **Urinary Bladder**

A hollow, distensible muscular organ located in the pelvic cavity posterior to the pubic symphysis, serving as a reservoir for urine.

### **Urinary Incontinence**

Involuntary leakage of urine, significantly affecting

psychological, social, and physical well-being.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bladder Control, Loss Of Incontinence, Urinary Loss Of Bladder Control

### **Urinary Retention**

Inability to completely empty the bladder, which can be acute (sudden, painful, inability to void) or chronic (gradual, often painless, with overflow incontinence). Causes: benign prostatic hyperplasia, urethral stricture, neurogenic bladder, medications (anticholinergics), and pelvic organ prolapse.

### **Urinary Retraining**

Scheduled voiding and behavioral techniques used to improve bladder control and reduce urgency or incontinence.

### **Urinary Tract Infection**

Infection of the urinary tract, classified as lower infection such as cystitis or urethritis, or upper infection such as pyelonephritis. Symptoms vary; dysuria, frequency, urgency, fever, flank pain, or nausea may occur. *Escherichia coli* is a common cause, but organisms vary by setting and patient factors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bladder Infection (Urinary Tract Infection)

### **Urinary Tract Infection In Pregnancy**

A urinary infection or asymptomatic bacterial growth occurring during pregnancy. Pregnancy increases the risk of upper urinary infection, so screening and treatment follow pregnancy-specific clinical guidance.

### **Urinary Urgency**

A sudden, difficult-to-delay need to urinate. It may occur with urinary infection, bladder irritation, overactive bladder, stones, neurologic disease, or other conditions. Urgency with fever, flank pain, blood in the urine, or inability to urinate requires medical assessment.

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## Urination

The biological process of releasing urine from the bladder through the urethra out of the body; also known as micturition.

**Synonyms:**  
micturition.

## Urine Albuminuria

Abnormal urinary loss of albumin resulting from increased glomerular permeability or impaired tubular reclamation. Persistent albuminuria is independently associated with CKD progression and cardiovascular risk, even when eGFR is preserved.

## Urine Analysis

Laboratory examination of urine for cells, blood, proteins, glucose, microorganisms, and other substances.

## Urine Drug Screen

Immunoassay-based screening for common drugs of abuse in urine. Detects: amphetamines, benzodiazepines, cocaine (benzoylecgonine), opiates (morphine, codeine, heroin), oxycodone, methadone, fentanyl, barbiturates, PCP, THC (cannabinoids), and alcohol. Pros: rapid (minutes at POC), inexpensive.

## Urine Formation

The process by which the kidney produces urine through three steps: glomerular filtration (formation of 180 L/day ultrafiltrate), tubular reabsorption (return of 99 percent of water and most solutes), and tubular secretion (active addition of waste and ions).

## Urine HCG (Pregnancy Test)

Rapid point-of-care test detecting human chorionic gonadotropin in urine. Sensitivity: detects as low as 25 mIU/mL. Positive as early as 12-14 days after conception (before missed period). Results in 3-5 minutes. False negative: dilute urine, very early pregnancy, ectopic pregnancy.

**Synonyms:**  
Pregnancy Test

## Urine Osmolality

Concentration of urine relative to plasma normally 50 to 1200 mOsm/kg. High greater than 500 in prerenal states reflecting intact concentrating ability. Low less than 350 indicates impaired concentrating ability in diabetes insipidus, chronic kidney disease, and excessive fluid intake. More precise than specific gravity.

## Urine Sediment

Microscopic examination of centrifuged urine providing diagnostic information about renal pathology. Normal findings include few RBCs, WBCs, and hyaline casts.

## Urine Sodium

Concentration of sodium in urine measured in mEq/L. Low less than 20 in prerenal states reflecting avid tubular reabsorption. High greater than 40 in intrinsic renal disease, diuretic use, and salt-wasting nephropathies. Should be interpreted in context of volume status, medications, and concurrent therapies.

## Urine Toxicology

Laboratory analysis of urine for medicines, drugs, or their metabolites. Results require interpretation because detection does not always establish impairment or the timing of exposure.

## Urodynamic Testing

Suite of diagnostic procedures designed to evaluate the physiological function of the lower urinary tract (bladder and urethral sphincter) during filling, storage, and emptying phases.

## Urodynamics

A set of tests that assess the function of the lower urinary tract (bladder and urethra).

## Uroflow

Measurement of the rate and pattern of urine flow during voiding.

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## **Uroflowmetry**

Uroflowmetry examines uroflowmetry; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question. and testing conditions; a low or abnormal flow may reflect obstruction, weak bladder contraction, or inadequate effort and requires clinical correlation.

## **Urolithiasis**

Formation of stones in the urinary tract, including the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra. Stone composition varies by population and may include calcium oxalate, calcium phosphate, uric acid, struvite, or cystine.

## **Urologic Diagnostic Yield**

The proportion of urologic diagnostic procedures or tests that provide a definitive and clinically useful result.

## **Urology**

Surgical and medical specialty concerned with the study, diagnosis, and management of diseases affecting the male and female urinary tract (kidneys, ureters, urinary bladder, urethra) and the male reproductive system (prostate, testes, epididymis, seminal vesicles, penis).

## **Urothelial Carcinoma**

Urothelial carcinoma, previously called transitional cell carcinoma, is the most common malignancy of the urinary tract, arising from the urothelium that lines the renal pelvis, ureters, bladder, and proximal urethra.

## **Urothelium**

The specialized transitional epithelium lining the renal pelvis, ureters, bladder, and part of the urethra.

## **Urticaria**

A skin reaction causing transient, itchy raised welts that change location and usually resolve within 24 hours. It may occur with angioedema, which is deeper swelling often affecting the lips, eyelids, tongue, or extremities.

## **Urticaria Multiforme**

A hypersensitivity reaction in children, often triggered by infections or medications, characterised by widespread, annular or polycyclic erythematous plaques with dusky, ecchymotic, or targetoid centres and pseudovesication, differing from true urticaria by the presence of dusky discolouration and prolonged lesion duration.

## **Urticaria Pigmentosa**

A cutaneous form of mastocytosis in which excessive mast cells accumulate in the skin, producing tan or brown macules or papules that may swell and itch when rubbed. Flushing, abdominal symptoms, or systemic involvement can occur.

## **Usher Syndrome**

An inherited disorder combining sensorineural hearing loss with retinitis pigmentosa, the most common cause of combined deaf-blindness. Three types are distinguished by severity and age of onset; management requires coordinated audiological, ophthalmological, and genetic care.

## **Usual Interstitial Pneumonia**

The histopathological pattern in IPF with temporal heterogeneity, fibroblast foci, and honeycombing. HRCT shows basal-predominant, subpleural reticular opacities with traction bronchiectasis.

## **Uterine Atony**

Failure of the uterus to contract adequately after delivery, resulting in postpartum hemorrhage. The most common cause of PPH. Risk factors include prolonged labor, multiple gestation, macrosomia, oxytocin augmentation, and uterine fibroids. Diagnosis is clinical: boggy, soft uterus with excessive bleeding.

## **Uterine Balloon Tamponade**

A minimally invasive technique for managing postpartum hemorrhage due to uterine atony when uterotonics fail. A balloon (Bakri Postpartum Balloon, 500-1000 mL capacity) is inserted transvaginally into the uterine cavity and inflated with saline until bleeding stops. The balloon provides mechani-

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cal compression against the uterine wall.

### **Uterine Cancer**

Cancer arising in the uterus, most commonly from the endometrium. Abnormal vaginal bleeding, bleeding after menopause, pelvic pain, or unusual discharge requires evaluation; early diagnosis often permits effective treatment.

### **Uterine Fibroid (Leiomyoma)**

A benign tumor arising from the smooth muscle of the uterus. Fibroids may be submucosal, intramural, or subserosal and may cause heavy menstrual bleeding, pelvic pressure, pain, urinary symptoms, or reproductive problems.

#### **Synonyms:**

Leiomyoma

### **Uterine Fibroids**

Benign tumors of uterine smooth muscle, also called leiomyomas. They may cause heavy menstrual bleeding, pelvic pressure, pain, infertility, or no symptoms.

#### **Synonyms:**

leiomyomas. Polyps Uterus (Uterine Fibroids) Tumors Uterine (Uterine Fibroids) Womb Growths (Uterine Fibroids)

### **Uterine Hemorrhage**

Heavy or abnormal bleeding from the uterus, occurring during pregnancy, after childbirth, or at other times. Causes include pregnancy complications, fibroids, hormonal disorders, and malignancy; severe bleeding with dizziness or weakness is an emergency.

### **Uterine Inversion**

A rare but life-threatening obstetric emergency where the uterus turns inside out, protruding through the cervix or vaginal introitus. Occurs in 1:2000-1:20,000 deliveries. Causes: fundal pressure, excessive cord traction (especially with fundal placenta), uterine atony, and fundal fibroids.

### **Uterine Perforation**

A full-thickness breach of the uterine wall, most

commonly occurring during instrumentation such as dilation and curettage or hysteroscopy, potentially causing hemorrhage and requiring surgical repair.

### **Uterine Prolapse**

Descent of the uterus toward or through the vaginal opening because the supporting pelvic floor and ligaments have weakened. Risk factors include childbirth, aging, obesity, and conditions that increase chronic pressure in the abdomen.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pelvic Support Problems, Uterine Prolapse Proapsed Uterus

### **Uterine Rupture**

A full-thickness tear through the uterine wall, potentially life-threatening to both mother and fetus. Risk factors include prior caesarean section (especially classical incision), oxytocin augmentation, and operative vaginal delivery. Presents with sudden abdominal pain, loss of fetal heart rate, and maternal hemorrhage.

### **Uterine Tachysystole**

More than five uterine contractions in 10 minutes averaged over 30 minutes, whether or not accompanied by fetal heart-rate abnormalities. It can reduce uteroplacental perfusion, particularly when caused by oxytocin or prostaglandins.

### **Uterotonic**

A medication that stimulates uterine contraction, used for induction/augmentation of labor, prevention and treatment of postpartum hemorrhage, and medical termination of pregnancy.

### **Uterus**

Hollow muscular organ in the pelvis between the bladder and rectum, approximately 7.5 cm long in adult females, responsible for menstruation, implantation, and fetal development during pregnancy.

**Common name:** Womb

### **UTI**

Infection of the urinary tract, classified as lower

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(cystitis, urethritis) or upper (pyelonephritis). See Urinary Tract Infection.

### **UV Light**

Ultraviolet radiation, an invisible part of sunlight or artificial light that can affect the skin and eyes and may cause sunburn, aging, or skin cancer.

### **Uvea**

The uvea is the vascular middle layer of the eye, comprising the iris, ciliary body, and choroid; it regulates light entry, supports the lens, and supplies the outer retina. focus, and blood supply to the eye.

### **Uveal Melanoma**

The most common primary intraocular malignancy in adults, arising from melanocytes within the uveal tract (choroid, ciliary body, or iris), presenting with visual symptoms, a pigmented intraocular mass, or incidental finding on examination.

### **Uveitis**

Uveitis is inflammation of the uveal tract and adjacent eye structures, causing pain, redness, light sensitivity, floaters, or impaired vision from infectious, autoimmune, traumatic, or other causes. or reduced vision; causes include infection, autoimmune disease, and other inflammatory conditions.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chorioretinitis (Uveitis)

### **Uveoparotid Fever**

A manifestation of sarcoidosis characterized by the triad of bilateral parotid gland enlargement, anterior uveitis, and fever, sometimes associated with facial nerve palsy. It reflects granulomatous inflammation and is treated with systemic corticosteroids and potentially disease-modifying agents.

### **Uvula**

A small, fleshy flap of tissue that hangs from the back of the throat over the root of the tongue.

### **Uvulitis**

Uvulitis is inflammation and swelling of the uvula from infection, trauma, allergy, dehydration, or irritation and may interfere with swallowing or airway protection. dehydration, or irritation. It may cause throat pain, difficulty swallowing, gagging, or a foreign-body sensation; marked swelling with breathing difficulty requires urgent assessment.

### **Ureteral Calculi**

Stones that form in or pass through a ureter, the tube carrying urine from a kidney to the bladder.

### **Urea**

The principal nitrogen-containing waste product of protein metabolism, formed in the liver and excreted mainly by the kidneys.

### **Urinary Frequency**

The need to urinate more often than usual, which may result from infection, bladder irritation, increased urine production, or other urinary disorders.

### **Urinary Lithiasis**

The formation or presence of stones anywhere in the urinary tract, including the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra.

### **Urinary Stasis**

Slowing or stopping of normal urine flow, which can promote urinary infection, stone formation, or obstruction-related kidney injury.

### **Urinometer**

A hydrometer used to measure the specific gravity of urine.

### **Urogenital Tract**

The combined urinary and reproductive organs and passages, which develop from related embryologic structures.

### **Uterine Fibroid Embolization**

A minimally invasive procedure that blocks the arteries supplying uterine fibroids, causing them to



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shrink.

### **Uterine Tube**

A paired muscular tube that transports the oocyte from the ovary toward the uterus and is the usual site of fertilization.

### **Ulnar Wrist Pain**

Pain on the side of the wrist nearest the little finger, often involving the ulna or nearby tendons and ligaments.

#### **Synonyms:**

Ulnar-Sided Wrist Pain

### **Undescended Testicle**

A testicle that has not moved into the scrotum before birth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Testicle, Undescended

### **Undifferentiated Pleomorphic Sarcoma**

An uncommon aggressive cancer of soft tissue or bone whose cells have no clearly identifiable line of differentiation.

#### **Synonyms:**

Malignant Fibrous Histiocytoma

### **Urinary Catheter**

A hollow, flexible tube inserted through the urethra into the bladder to drain urine; it may be used intermittently or left in place.

### **Upper Respiratory Infection**

An infection of the nose, sinuses, pharynx, or larynx, most often caused by a virus and producing symptoms such as congestion, sore throat, cough, or runny nose.

### **Ulnar Nerve Entrapment**

Compression or irritation of the ulnar nerve, commonly at the elbow or wrist, causing numbness or tingling in the ring and little fingers and sometimes weakness of the hand.

### **Ulcerative Proctitis**

Inflammation and ulceration limited to the lining of the rectum, often causing rectal bleeding, urgency, tenesmus, mucus, and diarrhea.

### **Ulcerative Keratitis**

An ulcerative infection or inflammatory defect of the cornea that can cause pain, redness, photophobia, and impaired vision and may threaten sight if untreated.

### **Urticarial Vasculitis**

Inflammation of small blood vessels associated with hive-like lesions that often last longer than ordinary urticaria and may burn, bruise, or leave residual discoloration.

### **Ulnar Paradox**

The clinical observation that a lesion of the ulnar nerve at the wrist may cause more clawing of the fingers than a lesion higher in the forearm, because the ulnar-innervated finger flexors remain intact.

### **Uraemic Syndrome**

The collection of symptoms and biochemical abnormalities caused by severe accumulation of uraemic waste products in advanced kidney failure.

### **Urethral Syndrome**

Urinary frequency, urgency, dysuria, or discomfort without a clear bacterial urinary-tract infection; causes may include irritation, pelvic-floor dysfunction, or inflammation.

### **Urethroplasty**

Surgical reconstruction or widening of the urethra, most commonly to treat a urethral stricture.

### **Urethroscopy**

Endoscopic examination of the urethra using a urethroscope, sometimes combined with treatment of a stricture or other lesion.

### **Urinary Casts**

Cylindrical structures formed in renal tubules and

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passed in urine; their type can help identify kidney disease, such as glomerular inflammation or tubular injury.

### **Urobilinogen**

A colourless product formed in the intestine from bilirubin and partly reabsorbed and excreted in urine; abnormal levels may provide clues to liver disease or haemolysis.

### **Utricle**

One of the otolith organs of the inner ear, detecting horizontal linear acceleration and head position relative to gravity.

### **Uvulopalatopharyngoplasty (UPPP)**

A surgical procedure that removes or reshapes selected tissue of the soft palate, uvula, and pharynx to enlarge the upper airway. It may be used in selected patients with obstructive sleep apnea, but effectiveness and risks depend on airway anatomy and other treatments.

### **Ubidecarenone**

Coenzyme Q10, a lipid-soluble molecule involved in mitochondrial electron transport and cellular energy production; it is sold as a supplement and studied in selected cardiovascular and neuromuscular conditions.

### **Ubiquitin**

A small regulatory protein that is covalently attached to other proteins to label them for degradation by the proteasome or to alter their cellular trafficking and signaling.

### **Ubiquitination**

Ubiquitination is attachment of ubiquitin to a target protein through an E1–E2–E3 enzyme cascade, marking it for proteasomal degradation or altering its localization, activity, or signaling.

### **Ulocladium**

A genus of dematiaceous filamentous fungi found in soil and plant material. It is an uncommon oppor-

tunistic pathogen that can cause keratitis, sinusitis, or invasive infection in susceptible people.

### **Ultracentrifugation**

Ultracentrifugation separates particles or macromolecules at very high centrifugal force according to size, shape, and density; it is used to study viruses, organelles, lipoproteins, and protein complexes.

### **Ultradian Rhythm**

A biological rhythm that repeats more than once in 24 hours, such as pulsatile hormone secretion, sleep-stage cycling, or periodic changes in heart and breathing patterns.

### **Ultrafiltration**

Pressure-driven movement of water and small solutes across a semipermeable membrane while retaining larger molecules or particles. It contributes to glomerular filtration and is used in dialysis and laboratory processing.

### **Ultralente Insulin**

Ultralente insulin is a prolonged-acting zinc insulin suspension formerly used for basal insulin replacement; it has largely been replaced by newer long-acting analogues and can cause hypoglycaemia and dosing variability.

### **Ultrasonic Therapy**

ultrasonic therapy is used in relation to ultrasonic therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Ultrasound Biomicroscopy**

High-frequency ultrasound imaging used to visualize the anterior segment of the eye, including the cornea, iris, ciliary body, lens, and angle when ordinary examination or imaging is insufficient.

### **Ultraviolet Microscopy**

Microscopy that uses ultraviolet wavelengths to produce images or fluorescence from structures and substances that absorb or emit ultraviolet light. It has specialized laboratory and research applications.

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### **Ultraviolet Rays**

Invisible electromagnetic radiation with wavelengths shorter than visible violet light. Excess exposure can cause sunburn, photoaging, eye injury, and skin cancers; controlled ultraviolet exposure has selected therapeutic uses.

### **Ultraviolet Therapy**

ultraviolet therapy is used in relation to ultraviolet therapy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Umbilical Vein**

The umbilical vein carries oxygen- and nutrient-rich blood from the placenta to the fetus during pregnancy.

### **Undifferentiated Carcinoma**

A neoplasm involving undifferentiated carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Undulate Ribs**

Ribs with a wavy or irregular contour, a descriptive anatomic finding that may reflect a developmental variation, deformity, prior injury, or underlying bone disease.

### **Unilaminar Epithelium**

An epithelium consisting of a single layer of cells. Its structure is adapted for functions such as diffusion, absorption, secretion, or filtration depending on the organ.

### **Unilateral**

Affecting, occurring on, or involving one side of the body or one paired organ, such as unilateral weakness or unilateral eye disease.

### **Unilateral Microphthalmos**

A congenital condition in which one eye is abnormally small. It may be associated with other ocular malformations and can cause substantial visual impairment.

### **Uninodular Goiter**

A goiter containing one dominant thyroid nodule. Evaluation generally includes thyroid-function testing and imaging, with further assessment to determine whether the nodule is benign or malignant.

### **Unipolar Neuron**

A neuron with a single process extending from its cell body. True unipolar neurons occur in some invertebrates; many sensory neurons in humans are more accurately described as pseudounipolar.

### **Unresectable**

Describing a tumor or lesion that cannot be completely removed safely by surgery because of its location, extent, invasion of vital structures, or the patient's operative risk.

### **Unsaturated Phytosterol**

A plant sterol containing one or more carbon-carbon double bonds. Phytosterols can reduce intestinal cholesterol absorption, although clinical effects depend on intake, formulation, and patient context.

### **Untranslated Region**

A molecular or cellular process involving untranslated region. Its role depends on the relevant genes, molecules, cells, and physiological context.

### **Upamostat**

An investigational small-molecule serine-protease inhibitor studied for inflammatory and infectious diseases. It is not an established routine treatment, and its clinical role depends on trial evidence and regulatory approval.

### **Upper Extremity**

The anatomic region extending from the shoulder through the arm, forearm, wrist, and hand. Disorders may involve its bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, or skin.

### **Urachus**

An embryologic connection between the fetal bladder and umbilicus that normally becomes the me-

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dian umbilical ligament after birth. Persistent urachal remnants can form cysts, sinuses, or other complications.

### Uracil

A pyrimidine nitrogenous base found principally in RNA. It pairs with adenine and is also a component of several metabolic intermediates and nucleotide medicines.

### Uracil Mustard

An older nitrogen-mustard alkylating compound related to uracil and studied or used historically as an antineoplastic drug. Its clinical use is limited by toxicity and the availability of newer treatments.

### Uracil Nucleotides

Nucleotides containing uracil, including UMP, UDP, and UTP. They participate in RNA synthesis, carbohydrate metabolism, and activation of sugars for glycoconjugate production.

### Uranium

A naturally occurring radioactive heavy metal. Internal exposure can damage the kidneys, while inhaled or retained radioactive material can also expose tissues to ionizing radiation.

### Ureaplasma

A genus of very small bacteria without a cell wall that can colonize the genital or urinary tract and is sometimes associated with urethritis or pregnancy complications.

### Ureaplasma Urealyticum

ureaplasma urealyticum is a bacterial taxon; disease risk and clinical significance depend on the strain, specimen source, host factors, and evidence of infection rather than colonization.

### Ureter Fissus

A congenital longitudinal splitting or duplication anomaly of the ureter. Its clinical importance depends on the anatomy and whether it causes reflux, obstruction, infection, or impaired drainage.

### Ureter Obstruction

Blockage of urine flow from a kidney to the bladder, commonly caused by a stone, stricture, tumor, or external compression and potentially leading to hydronephrosis, infection, or kidney injury.

### Ureteral Catheters

Thin tubes passed into the ureter to drain urine, inject contrast, measure pressure, or guide procedures. Complications include infection, bleeding, perforation, migration, and obstruction.

### Ureteral Polyp

Usually a benign fibroepithelial growth arising from the ureter. It may cause hematuria, flank pain, or obstruction and must be distinguished from urothelial malignancy when evaluated.

### Ureteral Stenosis

Narrowing of the ureter caused by scar tissue, prior surgery, radiation, stones, inflammation, or congenital disease, impairing urine drainage and possibly causing hydronephrosis or recurrent infection.

### Ureteric Perforation

A clinical condition or process involving ureteric perforation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Ureteroscopes

Small endoscopes used to inspect the ureter and renal collecting system and to perform procedures such as stone removal, biopsy, or stent placement.

### Ureterostomy Procedure

Surgery that creates an opening from a ureter to the skin or another urinary conduit to divert urine when normal drainage to the bladder is impossible or must be bypassed.

### Urethan

An older name for ethyl carbamate, a chemical compound with carcinogenic potential in experimental and exposure settings. It is not a routine therapeutic medicine.

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## Urethra Disorder

A condition affecting the urethra, such as infection, inflammation, stricture, trauma, congenital abnormality, or tumor, that may cause pain, discharge, weak stream, or retention.

## Urethral Carcinoma

A neoplasm involving urethral carcinoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

## Urethral Catheter

A tube inserted through the urethra into the bladder to drain urine, obtain a specimen, instill medication, or monitor output. Urinary infection and urethral trauma are important risks.

## Urethral Fistula

An abnormal channel between the urethra and another epithelial surface, often the vagina or skin. It can cause continuous urine leakage, recurrent infection, and local irritation.

## Urethral Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of urine leaving the bladder, often from stricture, stone, prostate disease, tumor, or a congenital valve; acute retention requires prompt treatment.

## Urethral Sphincter

The muscular mechanism that helps maintain urinary continence by compressing the urethra. It includes smooth and striated muscle components controlled by autonomic and voluntary pathways.

## Urethral Stenosis

Scar-related narrowing of the urethral channel that restricts urinary flow and can cause spraying, weak stream, recurrent infection, retention, or bladder damage.

## Uric Acid

The end product of purine breakdown in humans, eliminated mainly in urine. Increased levels can contribute to gout or uric-acid kidney stones.

## Uricosuric Agent

A medicine that increases renal excretion of uric acid, lowering serum urate in selected patients with gout. Adequate kidney function and hydration are important, and urinary uric-acid stones may be a concern.

## Uridine

A nucleoside composed of uracil linked to ribose. It is a building block of RNA and a precursor of uridine nucleotides involved in carbohydrate and membrane metabolism.

## Uridine Diphosphate

A nucleotide consisting of uridine and two phosphate groups. UDP participates in glycogen metabolism and transfers activated sugars during glycosylation reactions.

## Uridine Monophosphate

A nucleotide consisting of uridine and one phosphate group. UMP is a component of RNA and an intermediate in pyrimidine-nucleotide metabolism.

## Uridine Triacetate

An oral prodrug that supplies uridine and is used as an emergency antidote for severe or life-threatening toxicity from fluorouracil or related fluoropyrimidines, under specialist direction.

## Uridine Triphosphate

A high-energy uridine nucleotide used in RNA synthesis and in the formation of activated sugar donors for glycogen and glycoprotein production.

## Urinary Bladder Disorder

A disease affecting bladder storage or emptying, including infection, overactivity, pain syndrome, stones, tumor, neurologic dysfunction, or outlet obstruction.

## Urinary Calculi

Stones formed from crystallized minerals in the urinary tract. They may cause colicky pain, hematuria, obstruction, infection, or kidney injury depending

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on their size and location.

### **Urinary Catheterization**

A clinical condition or process involving urinary catheterization. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Urinary Diversion**

Surgical or catheter-based rerouting of urine when the normal passage from the kidneys to the urethra cannot be used, often to a stoma or bowel reservoir.

### **Urinary Fistula**

An abnormal connection between part of the urinary tract and another organ or the skin, allowing urine to leak outside its normal pathway. Causes include surgery, childbirth injury, inflammation, and cancer.

### **Urinary Hesitation**

A clinical condition or process involving urinary hesitation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Urinary System**

The kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra, which produce, transport, store, and eliminate urine while regulating fluid, electrolytes, acid–base balance, and blood pressure.

### **Urinary Tract Disorder**

Any disease of the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra, including infection, stones, obstruction, congenital abnormalities, cancer, and functional or neurologic disorders.

### **Urinary Tract Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving urinary tract neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Urination Disorder**

Abnormal storage or emptying of urine causing frequency, urgency, dysuria, incontinence, hesitancy, weak stream, retention, or excessive or reduced urine output.

### **Urine Conductivity**

Urine conductivity measures how readily urine carries electrical current and reflects its dissolved electrolyte and solute concentration.

### **Urine Cytology**

Microscopic examination of cells shed into urine, mainly used to help detect high-grade urothelial carcinoma and some other abnormalities. A negative result does not exclude all urinary-tract cancers.

### **Urochordata**

A subphylum of chordates, also called tunicates, whose members include sea squirts. They are primarily biological research organisms rather than human pathogens.

### **Urogenital Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the urinary and genital tracts, such as a vesicovaginal or ureterovaginal fistula. It commonly causes continuous urinary leakage and requires specialist evaluation.

### **Urogenital System**

The related urinary and reproductive organs and their associated ducts, vessels, and supporting tissues. The systems share developmental origins and anatomic relationships.

### **Urostomy Leak**

Escape of urine beneath or around a urostomy appliance or from a surgical connection. Persistent leakage can irritate the skin and may signal poor appliance fit, obstruction, infection, or a surgical complication.

### **Urostomy Procedure**

Surgery that diverts urine through a stoma into an external pouch or conduit, commonly after bladder removal or when the lower urinary tract cannot safely transport urine.

### **Urostomy Prolapse**

Protrusion of a segment of bowel used as a urostomy stoma beyond its usual level. It may cause bleed-



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ing, swelling, appliance problems, or impaired urine drainage and should be assessed clinically.

### **Urostomy Stenosis**

Narrowing of a urinary stoma or conduit that impedes drainage, causing reduced urine output, leakage, infection, or kidney-pressure changes and sometimes requiring revision.

### **Ursodeoxycholic Acid**

A hydrophilic bile acid used for primary biliary cholangitis and selected cholestatic liver diseases; it may also dissolve certain small cholesterol gallstones when bile flow is preserved.

### **Ustekinumab**

Ustekinumab is a monoclonal antibody blocking interleukin-12 and interleukin-23 signaling, used for psoriasis, psoriatic arthritis, inflammatory bowel disease, and other approved conditions; infection risk and hypersensitivity require monitoring.

### **Ustilago**

A genus of smut fungi that infect plants, especially grasses and cereals. Human infection is rare and generally occurs as an opportunistic infection in people with impaired immunity.

### **Uterine Adnexae**

The uterine adnexa are structures beside the uterus, chiefly the fallopian tubes, ovaries, and supporting tissues.

### **Uterine Cavity**

The uterine cavity is the internal space of the uterus lined by endometrium and is where implantation and pregnancy occur.

### **Uterine Fistula**

A uterine fistula is an abnormal passage connecting the uterus with another organ or the skin, often after surgery, childbirth injury, infection, or cancer.

### **Uterine Gland**

uterine gland refers to a defined body structure, tis-

sue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Uterine Leiomyosarcoma**

A neoplasm involving uterine leiomyosarcoma. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Uterine Monitoring**

Assessment of uterine contractions and, in pregnancy, their frequency, duration, and strength to evaluate labor progress, induction response, or excessive uterine activity.

### **Uterine Myomectomy**

uterine myomectomy is used in relation to uterine myomectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

### **Uterine Obstruction**

Blockage that prevents normal passage through the uterus or cervix, which may cause menstrual outflow obstruction, infertility, pregnancy complications, or retained blood or tissue.

### **Uterus Disorder**

A condition affecting the uterus, including fibroids, adenomyosis, endometriosis, infection, abnormal bleeding, congenital anomalies, prolapse, and cancer.

### **Uterus Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving uterus neoplasm. Diagnosis establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Uveal Disease**

A disorder of the iris, ciliary body, or choroid, including uveitis, tumors, vascular disease, and inflammation that may cause eye pain, photophobia, floaters, or visual loss.

### **Uveal Neoplasm**

A neoplasm involving uveal neoplasm. Diagnosis

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establishes the tumour type, extent, biological behaviour, and appropriate management.

### **Umbilical Catheters**

Umbilical catheters provide vascular access through a newborn's umbilical vessels for fluids, medicines, monitoring, or blood sampling while complications are monitored.

### **Undescended Testicle Repair**

Undescended testicle repair examines undescended testicle repair; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Upper Airway Biopsy**

Upper airway biopsy examines upper airway biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Upper GI And Small Bowel Series**

Upper GI and small bowel series examines upper gi and small bowel series; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urea Nitrogen Urine Test**

Urea nitrogen urine test examines urea nitrogen urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Ureteral Retrograde Brush Biopsy**

Ureteral retrograde brush biopsy examines ureteral retrograde brush biopsy; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urethral Discharge Culture**

Urethral discharge culture examines urethral discharge culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Uric Acid - Blood**

Uric acid - blood is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Uric Acid Urine Test**

Uric acid urine test examines uric acid urine test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urinary Catheters**

Urinary catheters drain the bladder when a person cannot empty it normally or accurate urine measurement is needed, with risks including infection, trauma, blockage, and discomfort.

### **Urinary Incontinence Products**

Urinary-incontinence products such as pads, protective underwear, catheters, and mattress covers manage leakage but do not treat its underlying cause.

### **Urine 24-Hour Volume**

Twenty-four-hour urine volume is the total urine produced in a day and helps assess hydration, kidney function, endocrine disease, or abnormal urine production.

### **Urine Chemistry**

Urine chemistry examines urine chemistry; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Concentration Test**

Urine concentration test examines urine concentration test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Culture**

Urine culture examines urine culture; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

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### **Urine Culture - Catheterized Specimen**

Urine culture - catheterized specimen examines urine culture - catheterized specimen; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Drainage Bags**

Urine drainage bags collect urine from a catheter or urinary diversion and require correct positioning, emptying, hygiene, and monitoring for blockage or infection.

### **Urine PH Test**

Urine pH test examines urine pH test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Protein Dipstick Test**

Urine protein dipstick test examines urine protein dipstick test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Protein Electrophoresis Test**

Urine protein electrophoresis test examines urine protein electrophoresis test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Urine Specific Gravity Test**

Urine specific gravity test examines urine specific gravity test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Uterine Sarcoma**

Uterine sarcoma is a rare malignant tumor arising from uterine muscle, connective tissue, or related cells and may cause bleeding, pain, or an enlarging mass.

### **Uterine Growths**

Uterine growths may include fibroids, polyps, adenomyosis, or rarely cancer. They can cause heavy or irregular bleeding, pelvic pressure, pain, infer-

tility, or no symptoms; examination and imaging determine the type and treatment.

### **UA**

UA commonly means urinalysis, laboratory examination of urine for blood, protein, cells, glucose, infection, and other findings.

### **Ubiquitous**

Present or found everywhere. In medical writing, the term is descriptive rather than a diagnosis and may refer to a substance, organism, or process that is widely distributed.

### **UBT**

UBT commonly means urea breath test, which detects active *Helicobacter pylori* infection by measuring labeled carbon dioxide after ingested urea.

### **UDP-Glucuronosyltransferase**

UDP-glucuronosyltransferase is an enzyme family that attaches glucuronic acid to bilirubin, medicines, hormones, and other compounds for elimination.

### **UL**

UL is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean upper limit, ulnar or ulna-related, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be specified.

### **Ulceration**

A clinical condition or process involving ulceration. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### **Umbilicus**

The navel, a scar on the anterior abdominal wall marking the former attachment of the umbilical cord. It can be affected by hernia, infection, discharge, or metastatic disease.

### **Unconscious**

Not awake and not responsive to ordinary external stimuli. Unconsciousness may result from syncope, seizure, trauma, intoxication, metabolic disease, stroke, or other emergencies.

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### Unconsciousness, Temporary

A brief episode of loss of awareness and responsiveness, often caused by syncope but also possible with seizure, concussion, hypoglycemia, or other conditions requiring assessment.

### Underventilation

A clinical condition or process involving underventilation. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

### Undifferentiated Cancer

A neoplastic condition involving undifferentiated Cancer; diagnosis establishes the tumor type, extent, and appropriate management.

### Undulate

To move or have a wave-like contour. In a clinical description, it may refer to a palpable fluid wave, a wavy tissue margin, or a rhythmic motion.

### United States Pharmacopeia

A nonprofit scientific organization that publishes quality standards for medicines, dosage forms, ingredients, dietary supplements, and related healthcare products. USP standards support identity, strength, purity, and performance testing.

### Unsteadiness

Impaired balance or gait stability, which may result from vestibular disease, neurologic disorders, weakness, medication effects, visual impairment, or musculoskeletal problems.

### Unwell

A general description of feeling ill or having reduced health, without identifying a specific disease. Persistent or severe symptoms require assessment for an underlying cause.

### Upper Leg

The portion of the lower limb between the hip and knee, containing the femur and the thigh muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

### Upper Motor Neuron

A neuron in the brain or spinal cord that influences lower motor neurons controlling skeletal muscle. Damage can cause weakness, spasticity, increased reflexes, and pathologic reflexes.

### Upregulation

A molecular or cellular process involving upregulation. Its role depends on the relevant genes, molecules, cells, and physiological context.

### Urate

The ionized form of uric acid, the end product of purine metabolism in humans. Excess serum urate can promote monosodium urate crystal deposition and gout.

### Urea Breath Test (UBT)

A diagnostic or laboratory method used to investigate the named clinical question; interpretation depends on the specimen, technique, reference range, and patient context.

### Urethral Meatus, Female

The external opening of the female urethra, located in the vestibule anterior to the vaginal opening. Its position and appearance may be relevant in urinary symptoms, congenital variation, or examination.

### URG

URG is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to urinary urgency or an urgent clinical priority; documentation should state the full term.

### URI

URI usually means upper respiratory infection, commonly a viral infection of the nose, throat, or upper airways causing congestion, cough, and sore throat.

### Urination, Difficulty

A clinical condition or process involving urination, difficulty. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

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## Urine Hemoglobin

Hemoglobin detected in urine, which may reflect intravascular hemolysis or contamination with intact red blood cells. Interpretation requires comparison with urine microscopy and clinical findings.

## Urine PH

A measurement of urine acidity or alkalinity. It varies with diet, metabolism, medications, infection, and kidney function and can influence the formation of some urinary stones.

## Urogenital

Relating to the urinary and reproductive systems or to structures that involve both systems.

## USFDA

The U.S. Food and Drug Administration regulates medicines, biologics, devices, food, and other products for safety, effectiveness, quality, and labeling.

## Ut Dict.

An abbreviation of the Latin phrase “ut dictum,” meaning “as stated” or “as directed.” In medical notes it refers the reader to information already given or to an instruction previously specified.

## Uterine Bleeding

Uterine bleeding is bleeding from the uterus and may result from menstruation, pregnancy complications, fibroids, polyps, hormonal disorders, cancer, or medicines.

## Uterine Contraction

A clinical condition or process involving uterine contraction. Its features, causes, evaluation, and management depend on the clinical context.

## Uterine Fornix

The uterine or vaginal fornix is a recess around the cervix where the upper vagina surrounds the projecting lower uterus.

## Uterine (Fallopian) Tubes

Paired muscular tubes extending from the uterus

toward the ovaries. They transport the oocyte and are the usual site of fertilization; blockage can contribute to infertility or ectopic pregnancy.

### Synonyms:

fallopian tubes; uterine tubes

## Uterine Polyps

Growths arising from the inner lining of the uterus that may cause irregular bleeding, heavy periods, or fertility problems.

### Synonyms:

Polyps, Endometrial Polyps, Uterine

## Uncertainty

Lack of complete certainty about a diagnosis, prognosis, measurement, or treatment effect. Clinical uncertainty is managed by combining available evidence with follow-up, additional testing, and shared decision-making.

## Undetermined

Not established or not able to be classified with the available clinical information. An undetermined result may require repeat assessment or additional testing.

## Undifferentiated

Lacking recognizable specialized features. In pathology, an undifferentiated tumor has cells that cannot be assigned readily to a specific tissue of origin based on their appearance.

## Unencoded Data

Health information that has not been converted into a defined coding system or standardized data format. It may require interpretation or data transformation before analysis or exchange.

## Unequivocal

Clear and not open to more than one reasonable interpretation. An unequivocal clinical finding or test result provides strong evidence for the stated interpretation when considered in context.

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## Unerupted Tooth

A tooth that has not emerged into the oral cavity at the expected time. It may be normally developing, delayed, impacted, or prevented from erupting by obstruction or abnormal position.

## Unevaluable

Unable to be assessed or interpreted reliably because of inadequate data, poor test quality, an unavailable endpoint, or another limiting circumstance.

## Unknown

Not known or not determined from the information currently available. In a medical record, an unknown value should be distinguished from a negative or normal result.

## Upper Arm

The portion of the upper limb between the shoulder and elbow, containing the humerus and muscles, nerves, and vessels that serve the arm.

## Ulcer Healing Drugs

Medicines used to promote healing of gastrointestinal ulcers, usually by suppressing acid secretion or protecting the mucosa; treatment also addresses causes such as *H. pylori* infection or NSAID use.

## Ultraviolet Rays (UVR)

Electromagnetic radiation beyond visible violet light. Excessive exposure can cause sunburn, photoaging, eye injury, and skin cancer.

## Uncinate Fit

A nonstandard or unclear historical label in the source dictionary; its intended clinical meaning should be verified against the original reference.

## Ungual

Relating to a nail or the nail apparatus.

## Unit

A standardized quantity used to express measurement, dosage, concentration, or a healthcare service.

## Upper Limb Disorders

Conditions affecting the shoulder, arm, elbow, forearm, wrist, or hand, including musculoskeletal, nerve, vascular, and work-related disorders.

## Urates

Salts or ions of uric acid. Monosodium urate crystals can accumulate in joints in gout, and urate crystals may contribute to urinary stones.

## Uretereroenterostomy

A urinary diversion procedure connecting a ureter to a segment of intestine; this spelling is a source variant of *ureteroenterostomy*.

## Ureteroscope

A slender endoscope used to inspect and treat the ureter and, when advanced, the renal pelvis.

## Urethra, Diseases Of And Injury To

Disorders or trauma affecting the urethra, including infection, stricture, diverticulum, obstruction, and laceration.

## Urethrocele

Prolapse or herniation of the urethra, usually into the anterior vaginal wall.

## Uricosuric Drug

A medicine that increases renal excretion of uric acid, such as probenecid, used in selected patients with gout.

## Urinary Bladder, Diseases Of

Disorders of the bladder, including infection, stones, tumors, neurogenic dysfunction, inflammation, obstruction, and impaired emptying.

## Urine Retention

Inability to empty the urinary bladder completely or at all. Acute retention can cause severe pain and requires prompt medical assessment.

## Urocele

An uncommon term for a cystic dilation or protru-



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sion involving a urinary-tract structure; the precise meaning depends on the anatomical context.

### **Urography**

Imaging of the urinary tract, traditionally using radiography after administration of a contrast medium.

### **Urokinase**

A plasminogen activator produced by the body and also used as a thrombolytic medicine to help dissolve blood clots.

### **URTI**

Abbreviation for upper respiratory tract infection, commonly involving the nose, sinuses, pharynx, or larynx and often caused by viruses.

### **Uterus, Diseases Of**

Disorders affecting the uterus, including fibroids, adenomyosis, endometriosis, infection, abnormal bleeding, prolapse, and cancer.

### **Untidy Wound**

An irregular or contaminated wound with crushing, devitalized tissue, tissue loss, foreign material, or associated injury to vessels, nerves, tendons, or bone. It has increased infection risk and may require exploration, irrigation, debridement, and delayed or staged closure.

### **Umbilical**

Relating to the umbilicus or navel, including structures, lesions, discharge, or abnormalities located at or connected with it.

### **Urine Alkalinization**

Deliberate increase of urine pH, usually with intravenous sodium bicarbonate, to enhance elimination of selected weak acids such as salicylate; it requires monitoring of pH, potassium, fluid status, and acid-base balance.

### **Unilateral Gynecomastia**

Enlargement of breast glandular tissue affecting

one breast in a male patient; a new, firm, fixed, painful, or nipple-associated mass requires clinical assessment.

### **Adenomyoma**

A benign uterine lesion composed of endometrial glands and stroma within a proliferation of smooth muscle; it may cause abnormal uterine bleeding or mimic other uterine tumors.

### **Arias-Stella Reaction**

A hormonally induced atypical change in endometrial or endocervical glands during pregnancy or exposure to progestins; it is benign and can mimic glandular neoplasia histologically.

### **Atypical Endometrial Hyperplasia**

A premalignant proliferation of endometrial glands with cytologic atypia, now commonly classified as endometrial intraepithelial neoplasia; it carries a risk of concurrent or subsequent endometrial carcinoma.

### **Endometrial Stromal Nodule**

A benign, well-circumscribed proliferation of endometrial stromal cells within the uterus, distinguished from endometrial stromal sarcoma by its lack of infiltrative margins or vascular invasion.

### **High-Grade Endometrial Stromal Sarcoma**

An aggressive malignant uterine stromal tumor with high-grade cytology and characteristic molecular alterations in some cases; it may invade the myometrium, vessels, or distant sites.

### **Low-Grade Endometrial Stromal Sarcoma**

A malignant uterine stromal tumor resembling proliferative-phase endometrial stroma, characterized by infiltrative myometrial or vascular growth and often driven by characteristic gene fusions.

### **Placental Site Nodule**

A benign, usually incidental remnant of intermediate trophoblast at a prior implantation site, composed of small nests of chorionic-type or extravillous

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trophoblast.

### **Urachal Carcinoma**

A rare malignant epithelial tumor arising from remnants of the embryonic urachus, usually located at the bladder dome or along the urachal tract. Most tumors are adenocarcinomas and may produce mucin, with local invasion and metastatic spread occurring in advanced disease. Clinical features can include hematuria, mucousuria, urinary symptoms, pelvic pain, or an incidental mass detected on imaging. Diagnosis requires cystoscopic and histopathologic evaluation with staging; treatment is based on resectability, local extension, and metastatic status.

### **Urosepsis**

Sepsis caused by infection of the urinary tract or urinary system, often associated with pyelonephritis, obstruction, catheterization, or an infected urinary calculus. The infection may progress from a localized urinary source to bacteremia, systemic inflammation, organ dysfunction, and septic shock. Clinical findings may include fever or hypothermia, flank pain, dysuria, hypotension, altered mental status, oliguria, or elevated lactate. Diagnosis combines clinical assessment with urine and blood cultures, laboratory testing, and imaging when obstruction or a complicated source is suspected.

## V

### **Vacuum Erection Devices**

Pumps that draw blood into the penis to produce an erection.

#### **Synonyms:**

Vacuum erection pump

### **Valvular Insufficiency**

Incomplete closure of a heart valve allowing retrograde blood flow (regurgitation); affects mitral, aortic, tricuspid, or pulmonic valves.

### **Variant Angina Pectoris**

Chest pain caused by temporary coronary-artery spasm, often occurring at rest.

#### **Synonyms:**

Prinzmetal angina; vasospastic angina

### **Vascular**

Relating to blood vessels.

### **Vascular Surgery**

Surgery that repairs or reroutes blood vessels to improve circulation.

### **Vasoconstrictor**

A substance that narrows blood vessels.

### **Vasodilator**

A substance that widens blood vessels.

### **Vasospasm**

Sudden involuntary narrowing caused by contraction of a blood vessel.

### **Venous**

Relating to veins.

### **Venous Leak**

Inadequate retention of blood in the penis during erection because blood escapes through veins.

#### **Synonyms:**

Veno-occlusive dysfunction

### **Ventricular Myocardium**

Heart muscle forming the walls of the ventricles.

### **Ventricular Rupture**

A tear in a ventricular wall, often a life-threatening complication of myocardial infarction.

### **Venules**

Very small veins that collect blood from capillaries.

### **Vertebral Artery**

An artery ascending through the neck that supplies blood to the brainstem and posterior brain.

### **Very Low-Calorie Diet**

A medically supervised diet providing about 800 or fewer calories per day.

#### **Synonyms:**

VLCD

### **Very-Low-Density Lipoprotein**

A lipoprotein that transports liver-produced triglycerides and can become LDL.

#### **Synonyms:**

VLDL

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## **Vestibular System**

Inner-ear and brain structures responsible for balance and spatial orientation.

## **Viral**

Caused by or relating to a virus.

## **Virulent**

Highly harmful, severe, or capable of causing serious disease.

## **Visualized Laser-Assisted Prostatectomy**

Laser prostate surgery performed with direct visualization to remove obstructing tissue.

### **Synonyms:**

VLAP

## **Vitamin D**

Vitamin D supports calcium and phosphate balance, bone mineralization, muscle function, and immune processes; deficiency causes rickets in children and osteomalacia or bone loss in adults.

## **VO2 Max**

The maximum rate at which the body can use oxygen during intense exercise.

### **Synonyms:**

Maximal oxygen consumption

## **Volatile Oils**

Plant oils containing compounds that evaporate readily at room temperature.

### **Synonyms:**

Essential oils

## **VSD**

Ventricular septal defect, a hole in the wall separating the heart's ventricles.

### **Synonyms:**

Ventricular septal defect

## **Vulnerable**

A substance traditionally believed to promote wound healing.

## **Vaccination**

Administration of a vaccine to stimulate immune response and provide protection against infectious disease. Types: live attenuated, inactivated, subunit, mRNA, viral vector. Schedule varies by country. Herd immunity achieved when sufficient proportion immune.

## **Vaccination Schedule**

A time-based plan for administering vaccines according to age, previous doses, medical conditions, exposure risks, and public-health guidance. Schedules vary by country and are updated as recommendations change.

## **Vaccine**

A biological preparation that stimulates an immune response to a pathogen or its components. Vaccines are used mainly to prevent infection or reduce disease severity; a limited number are used in therapeutic settings.

## **Vaccine Immunology**

The study of how vaccines stimulate innate and adaptive immune responses. Vaccine types include live attenuated, inactivated, subunit, conjugate, toxoid, viral-vector, and nucleic-acid vaccines; their immune responses, precautions, and schedules vary.

## **VACTERL Association**

A pattern of congenital abnormalities involving vertebral, anal, cardiac, tracheoesophageal, renal, and limb development. The diagnosis is considered when several component abnormalities occur together and other syndromes have been excluded.

## **Vacuum Delivery**

Assisted vaginal delivery using a vacuum extractor (cup applied to the fetal scalp with negative pressure) to expedite delivery for prolonged second stage, fetal distress, or maternal indications.

## **Vacuum-Assisted Delivery**

Operative vaginal delivery using a vacuum extractor applied to the fetal scalp. Types: soft cup (Kiwi OmniCup, Mityvac, for outlet and low deliveries)

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and rigid cup (metal Kiwi, for posterior positions and midpelvic deliveries).

## **Vagina**

The vagina is a muscular canal connecting the cervix to the external genital tract and serving roles in menstruation, sexual function, and childbirth. cm long in adult females. Functions include receiving the penis during intercourse, serving as the birth canal, and channeling menstrual flow.

## **Vaginal Atresia**

Congenital absence or complete obstruction of the vaginal canal. It may cause absent menstrual flow, cyclic pelvic pain, or difficulty with sexual activity and requires specialist evaluation.

## **Vaginal Cancer**

A rare gynecologic malignancy, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma linked to human papillomavirus. Treatment depends on stage and includes surgery, radiation, and chemotherapy.

### **Synonyms:**

Cancer, Vagina

## **Vaginal Delivery (Spontaneous)**

The spontaneous passage of the fetus through the birth canal without the use of operative instruments (vacuum or forceps). Typically occurs in the second stage of labor with maternal pushing.

### **Synonyms:**

Spontaneous

## **Vaginal Dryness**

Reduced vaginal lubrication, commonly associated with menopause, breastfeeding, hormonal changes, medications, or irritation. It may cause discomfort, itching, painful intercourse, or minor bleeding.

## **Vaginal Dryness And Atrophy (Genitourinary Syndrome Of Menopause)**

Vaginal dryness and atrophy, collectively termed genitourinary syndrome of menopause, result from declining estrogen levels that cause thinning, drying, and loss of elasticity of the vaginal tissues. Symp-

toms include vaginal dryness, irritation, burning, dyspareunia, and urinary symptoms such as frequency and recurrent infections.

### **Synonyms:**

Genitourinary Syndrome of Menopause

## **Vaginal Foreign Body**

An object retained in the vagina, most often a tampon or other inserted material. It may cause discharge, odor, bleeding, pain, or infection and should be removed safely with examination when necessary.

## **Vaginal Intercourse**

The insertion of the penis into the vagina for sexual pleasure or reproduction. The most common form of sexual intercourse. Vaginal intercourse can lead to pregnancy if sperm are deposited in the vagina.

## **Vaginal Bleeding During Early Pregnancy**

Bleeding from the vagina during the first part of pregnancy, caused by cervical changes, implantation, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, infection, or other conditions. Heavy bleeding, severe or one-sided pain, shoulder pain, dizziness, or fainting requires emergency assessment.

## **Vaginal Bleeding During Late Pregnancy**

Bleeding from the vagina later in pregnancy, which may be caused by placenta previa, placental abruption, labor, cervical disease, or other complications. Any significant late-pregnancy bleeding requires immediate obstetric assessment.

## **Vaginal Itching And Discharge**

Itching with abnormal vaginal discharge, commonly caused by candidiasis, bacterial vaginosis, sexually transmitted infection, dermatitis, hormonal change, or a retained foreign body. Odor, pelvic pain, fever, bleeding, pregnancy, or recurrent symptoms requires clinical evaluation and testing.

## **Vaginal Itching**

Itching or irritation of the vulva or vagina caused by candidiasis, bacterial vaginosis, sexually transmitted infections, dermatitis, hormonal changes, or other conditions. It may occur with discharge, odor,

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soreness, or burning; recurrent or unexplained symptoms require examination and appropriate testing rather than self-diagnosis.

### **Vaginal Microbiome**

The community of microorganisms living in the vagina, commonly dominated by *Lactobacillus* species that help maintain an acidic environment. Changes in this community may contribute to bacterial vaginosis, candidiasis, or other symptoms.

### **Vaginal Stenosis**

Narrowing or shortening of the vaginal canal, which may result from surgery, radiation, scarring, inflammation, trauma, or congenital development. It can cause pain, difficult examination, or difficulty with penetration.

### **Vaginal Trauma**

Injury to the vaginal tissues caused by childbirth, sexual activity, foreign objects, procedures, or blunt or penetrating trauma. Bleeding, pain, swelling, or urinary symptoms require assessment; severe bleeding or suspected deep injury is urgent.

### **Vaginal Hemorrhage**

Heavy or clinically significant bleeding from the vagina. Causes include childbirth, pregnancy complications, trauma, infection, structural disease, hormonal disorders, and gynecologic malignancy; severe or pregnancy-related bleeding requires urgent evaluation.

### **Vaginismus**

Involuntary tightening of the muscles around the vaginal opening that can make penetration painful or impossible. It may be associated with pelvic-floor dysfunction, fear, prior pain, or other factors and is treatable with a tailored multidisciplinary approach.

### **Vaginitis**

Inflammation of the vaginal mucosa, one of the most common gynecologic complaints.

### **Vaginospasm**

Involuntary contraction of the pelvic-floor muscles surrounding the vagina, causing pain or difficulty with vaginal penetration. It may be associated with fear of pain, prior trauma, pelvic-floor dysfunction, infection, hormonal factors, or other genitopelvic pain conditions.

### **Vagus Nerve (Cranial Nerve X)**

The tenth cranial nerve (CN X), the longest and most widely distributed cranial nerve in the body. It contains sensory, motor, and parasympathetic fibers, exiting the skull via the jugular foramen.

#### **Synonyms:**

Cranial Nerve X

### **Vagus Nerve Stimulation**

A neuromodulation treatment involving electrical stimulation of the left vagus nerve via an implanted device. It is FDA-approved for treatment-resistant depression and epilepsy. It requires surgical implantation and delivers intermittent stimulation. Improvement may take months to develop.

### **Valinemia**

A rare inherited disorder of branched-chain amino-acid metabolism causing elevated plasma valine. It may present with developmental delay, feeding difficulty, hypotonia, or neurological symptoms, although some individuals are minimally affected.

### **Valley Fever**

The common name for coccidioidomycosis, a fungal infection caused by *Coccidioides* species and acquired by inhaling airborne spores from soil. It usually causes a mild respiratory illness but can disseminate to skin, bone, joints, or meninges, especially in people at higher risk.

### **Valproate (Sodium Valproate)**

Valproate is a broad-spectrum antiseizure medicine used for several generalized and focal seizure disorders and for selected mood disorders. Choice requires consideration of age, pregnancy potential, liver disease, interactions, and other safety risks.

#### **Synonyms:**



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Sodium Valproate

### **Valsalva's Manoeuvre**

Forced expiratory effort against a closed airway (glottis closed or mouth and nose pinched shut), typically performed by bearing down as if straining during a bowel movement. The manoeuvre has four phases: Phase I (onset of straining): increased intrathoracic pressure compresses the aorta, causing a transient rise in blood pressure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Valsalva Maneuver

### **Valvular Heart Disease**

Valvular heart disease involves dysfunction of one or more heart valves, leading to stenosis, regurgitation, or a combination of both. The most common causes are degenerative calcification of aortic and mitral valves, rheumatic heart disease, infective endocarditis, and ischemic papillary muscle dysfunction.

### **Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococcus**

Enterococcus bacteria that are resistant to vancomycin, usually because of altered cell-wall precursors. VRE can cause healthcare-associated urinary, bloodstream, wound, or other infections and may require susceptibility-guided treatment.

### **Variable Decelerations**

Abrupt decreases in fetal heart rate that vary in timing, shape, and duration, commonly caused by umbilical-cord compression. Their significance depends on frequency, duration, associated baseline changes, variability, and the clinical setting.

### **Variceal Hemorrhage**

Life-threatening complication of portal hypertension involving rupture of dilated esophageal or gastric varices. The risk is determined by variceal size, red color signs, liver disease severity, and portal hypertension degree.

### **Varicella**

A primary infection with varicella-zoster virus that causes fever and a generalized itchy rash. See Chickenpox.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chickenpox (Varicella)

### **Varicella Vaccine**

A live attenuated vaccine that prevents or reduces the severity of chickenpox. The number and timing of doses depend on age, vaccination history, immune status, pregnancy, and local recommendations. It is generally avoided during pregnancy and in people with certain immune deficiencies.

### **Varicella-Zoster Virus**

A herpesvirus that causes chickenpox (varicella) and shingles (herpes zoster). VZV establishes latent infections in dorsal root ganglia and can reactivate decades later. Chickenpox is highly contagious and typically occurs in childhood. Reactivation as shingles causes painful dermatomal vesicular rash.

### **Varicocele**

A varicocele is enlargement of veins in the scrotum, often on the left, that may cause aching, testicular growth differences, infertility, or no symptoms. cord, resulting from incompetent or absent venous valves.

### **Varicose Ulcer**

Impaired venous return from the lower extremities due to venous valve incompetence or obstruction. See chronic venous insufficiency.

### **Varicose Veins**

Dilated, tortuous superficial veins, most commonly in the lower extremities. Caused by venous valve incompetence leading to venous reflux. Risk factors: family history, prolonged standing, obesity, pregnancy, and older age. Symptoms: leg heaviness, swelling, aching. Complications: skin changes, ulceration, thrombophlebitis.

### **Variegate Porphyrria**

An inherited hepatic porphyria caused by reduced protoporphyrinogen oxidase activity. It can cause acute neurovisceral attacks with abdominal pain and neuropathy and/or photosensitive blistering skin disease.

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## Variola

A highly contagious and deadly disease caused by variola virus, eradicated globally by 1980 through vaccination. See Smallpox.

## Vas Deferens

Muscular duct (approximately 45 cm long) transporting sperm from the epididymal tail to the ejaculatory duct. It ascends through the spermatic cord, passes through the inguinal canal, enters the pelvis, crosses over the ureter, and joins the seminal vesicle duct to form the ejaculatory duct (in the prostate).

## Vasa Previa

Fetal blood vessels traverse the membranes over or near the internal cervical os without protection from placental tissue or the umbilical cord. Rupture of membranes can cause rapid fetal exsanguination, so antenatal diagnosis and planned cesarean delivery are important.

## Vascular Access

A route into the bloodstream for treatment or monitoring. Hemodialysis access may be an arteriovenous fistula, arteriovenous graft, or central venous catheter; the choice depends on vascular anatomy, urgency, expected duration, and individual risks.

## Vascular Access For Hemodialysis

A surgically created or catheter-based route that permits high-flow blood removal and return during hemodialysis. Arteriovenous fistulae are generally preferred when feasible, followed by grafts; central venous catheters have higher infection and thrombosis risks.

## Vascular Dementia

Cognitive impairment caused by cerebrovascular disease, such as strokes or chronic small-vessel injury. Symptoms may develop suddenly or gradually and can include problems with attention, executive function, memory, or walking. Management addresses the underlying vascular risks and functional needs.

### Synonyms:

Dementia, Vascular

## Vascular Diagnostic Yield

The proportion of vascular diagnostic procedures or tests that provide a clinically useful result.

## Vascular Graft

Synthetic or biologic conduit for vascular reconstruction. PTFE, Dacron, saphenous vein.

## Vascular Graft Patency

Continued openness and functional blood flow through a vascular graft or bypass. Patency is monitored clinically and with duplex or other imaging because thrombosis, stenosis, infection, intimal hyperplasia, and anastomotic problems can cause failure.

## Vascular Imaging

Techniques for visualizing blood vessels: duplex ultrasound, CT angiography, MR angiography, conventional angiography.

## Vascular Malformation

Abnormal blood vessel development. Arteriovenous malformation, venous malformation, lymphatic malformation.

## Vascular Ring

A congenital abnormality of the aortic arch or its branches that encircles and may compress the trachea, esophagus, or both. Symptoms include stridor, wheezing, recurrent respiratory infection, dysphagia, feeding difficulty, or respiratory distress.

## Vascular Trauma

Injury to an artery or vein from blunt, penetrating, iatrogenic, or crush mechanisms. Assessment prioritizes hemorrhage control, distal perfusion, ischemia, expanding hematoma, bruit, thrill, and associated nerve or bone injury.

## Vascularity

The amount and distribution of blood vessels supplying a tissue or lesion.

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## Vasculitis

Inflammation of blood vessels causing tissue ischemia and necrosis. Classification by vessel size. Large vessel: giant cell arteritis, Takayasu arteritis. Medium vessel: polyarteritis nodosa (PAN), Kawasaki disease.

### Synonyms:

Angiitis (Vasculitis)

## Vasculitis (Systemic)

Inflammation of blood vessels that may involve large, medium, or small vessels and impair blood flow or cause tissue injury. Examples include ANCA-associated vasculitis and IgA vasculitis.

### Synonyms:

Systemic

## Vasodilation

The widening of blood vessels during inflammation, resulting in increased blood flow to the affected area. This process is mediated primarily by histamine released from mast cell granules acting on H1 receptors, nitric oxide produced by endothelial nitric oxide synthase, and prostaglandins particularly PGE2.

## Vasomotor Rhinitis

Nonallergic inflammation of the nasal lining causing congestion, runny nose, or sneezing, often triggered by odors, temperature changes, or irritants.

## Vasopressin (Antidiuretic Hormone, ADH)

A hormone that increases water reabsorption in the kidney and can constrict blood vessels. It is released from the posterior pituitary.

### Synonyms:

Antidiuretic Hormone, ADH

## Vasopressors In Anesthesia

Medicines that increase vascular tone or cardiac output to support blood pressure during anesthesia or critical illness. The choice and dose depend on the cause of hypotension, heart rate, cardiac function, and local protocol; monitoring is required.

## Vasovagal Syncope

Reflex syncope mediated by increased vagal tone and withdrawal of sympathetic activity, causing bradycardia and/or vasodilation resulting in transient cerebral hypoperfusion. Triggers: prolonged standing, heat, pain, emotional stress. Preceded by prodrome (lightheadedness, nausea, diaphoresis, visual tunneling).

### Synonyms:

Neurocardiogenic Syncope

## Vaughan Williams Classification

The Vaughan Williams classification categorizes antiarrhythmic drugs into four classes based on their primary mechanism of action.

## VEAL CHOP Mnemonic

A memory aid for interpreting fetal heart rate patterns. VEAL: Variable decelerations Cord compression, Early decelerations Head compression, Accelerations OK (fetal well-being), Late decelerations Placental insufficiency.

## Vector

A living carrier, commonly an arthropod, that transmits an infectious agent between hosts. Biological vectors support replication or development of the agent; mechanical vectors transfer it without such biologic change.

## Vector Control

Reduction of vector populations. Examples: insecticides, larvicides, environmental modification, personal protection.

## Vector-Borne Disease

Disease transmitted by vector (insect, tick). Examples: malaria, dengue, Lyme disease.

## Vector-Borne Diseases

Diseases transmitted by arthropod vectors including mosquitoes, ticks, fleas, and sandflies. Major vector-borne diseases include malaria, dengue, Zika, chikungunya, Lyme disease, and leishmaniasis. Prevention through vector control, personal protection,

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and chemoprophylaxis is essential.

### **Vegetation**

A vegetation is a mass composed of platelets, fibrin, and microorganisms that forms on a heart valve or endocardial surface in the setting of infective endocarditis. The vegetation typically attaches to the valve leaflet on the low-pressure side and may progressively destroy the underlying valve tissue, causing valvular regurgitation.

### **Vein**

A blood vessel that carries deoxygenated blood toward the heart (except pulmonary veins, which carry oxygenated blood). Veins have thinner walls and larger lumens than arteries, with less smooth muscle and elastic tissue.

### **Vein-Graft Aneurysms**

Focal dilation of a venous bypass graft, most commonly a saphenous vein graft used in coronary artery bypass surgery. Rare but may cause graft thrombosis, distal embolization, compression of adjacent structures, or rupture. Diagnosis: coronary angiography or CT angiography. Treatment: re-intervention or medical management.

### **Vena Cava**

The two largest systemic veins returning deoxygenated blood to the right atrium. Superior Vena Cava (SVC): formed by brachiocephalic veins, drains head, neck, upper limbs, thorax (no valves). Inferior Vena Cava (IVC): formed by common iliac veins at L5, drains abdomen, pelvis, lower limbs (receives hepatic, renal, gonadal, lumbar veins).

### **Venereal Diseases**

Sexually transmitted infections are infections passed from one person to another through sexual contact, including vaginal, anal, and oral sex. See Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs).

### **Venesection (Phlebotomy)**

The controlled removal of blood from a vein for therapeutic or diagnostic purposes.

**Synonyms:**

Phlebotomy

### **Venography**

Imaging of veins, usually after contrast material is administered, to assess venous anatomy, obstruction, thrombosis, or malformation.

### **Venom**

A biological poison produced by a microorganism, plant, or animal that damages host tissues at low concentrations. See toxin.

### **Venomous Bite**

A bite that injects venom from an animal such as a snake, spider, or arthropod. Effects range from local pain and swelling to bleeding, paralysis, or systemic toxicity.

### **Venous Insufficiency**

Impaired venous return from the lower extremities due to venous valve incompetence or obstruction. See chronic venous insufficiency.

### **Venous Stasis Ulcer**

A chronic leg wound caused by venous hypertension and chronic venous insufficiency. It often occurs near the ankle and may be accompanied by edema, varicose veins, skin darkening, and lipodermatosclerosis.

### **Venous Thromboembolism In Pregnancy**

Pregnancy increases the risk of VTE (DVT and PE) by 5-10 fold due to a hypercoagulable state (increased fibrinogen, factors VII-XII, vWF, decreased protein S, and venous stasis from the gravid uterus).

### **Venous Thromboembolism Prophylaxis**

Measures used to reduce perioperative deep-vein thrombosis and pulmonary embolism, including early mobilization, mechanical compression, and pharmacologic anticoagulation when bleeding risk permits.

### **Venous Thrombosis**

The formation of a blood clot (thrombus) within a

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vein, most commonly in the deep veins of the lower extremities (deep vein thrombosis, DVT).

### **Venous Ulcer**

A chronic wound caused by impaired venous drainage, usually occurring near the ankle in a limb with chronic venous insufficiency.

### **Ventilation-Perfusion Scan**

Lung imaging assessing ventilation and perfusion. Mismatch indicates pulmonary embolism. Alternative to CTPA in renal impairment or contrast allergy.

### **Ventilation-Perfusion Mismatch**

Unequal matching of air reaching the alveoli and blood reaching the pulmonary capillaries. Low or high regional ratios can impair oxygen exchange and occur in conditions such as COPD, pneumonia, or pulmonary embolism.

### **Ventilation-Perfusion Ratio**

The relationship between alveolar ventilation and pulmonary capillary perfusion. Regional mismatch is a major cause of impaired oxygenation; low V/Q produces venous admixture, while high V/Q reflects wasted ventilation.

### **Ventilation/Perfusion Scan**

Pulmonary embolism diagnosis. Ventilation: inhaled Tc-99m DTPA aerosol. Perfusion: injected Tc-99m MAA. Mismatch (perfusion defect with preserved ventilation) suggests PE. High single-photon emission computed tomography (SPECT) sensitivity.

### **Ventilator**

Mechanical device providing ventilatory support. Modes: assist-control, SIMV, CPAP, PRVC. Parameters: tidal volume, respiratory rate, FiO<sub>2</sub>, PEEP.

### **Ventilator-Associated Pneumonia**

Pneumonia developing after at least 48 hours of mechanical ventilation. Diagnosis is based on clinical findings and respiratory evaluation; cultures may

help identify the organism but are not interpreted in isolation.

### **Ventilator-Induced Lung Injury**

Lung injury caused or amplified by mechanical ventilation, including volutrauma, barotrauma, atelectrauma, and biotrauma. Lung-protective ventilation limits tidal volume and excessive airway pressures while maintaining appropriate oxygenation and carbon-dioxide targets.

### **Ventral**

Relating to the belly or front side of the body; synonym for anterior in human anatomy.

### **Ventricle**

One of the two lower, thicker-walled chambers of the heart that pump blood out of the heart. The right ventricle pumps deoxygenated blood into the pulmonary artery (low-pressure system); the left ventricle pumps oxygenated blood into the aorta (high-pressure system, generating systemic blood pressure).

### **Ventricle (Brain)**

The interconnected system of fluid-filled cavities within the brain producing and containing cerebrospinal fluid: two lateral ventricles (cerebrum), third ventricle (diencephalon), and fourth ventricle (pons/medulla, continuous with the central canal).

#### **Synonyms:**

Brain

### **Ventricular Arrhythmia**

An abnormal heart rhythm arising from the ventricles. It may cause palpitations, dizziness, fainting, chest discomfort, or sudden cardiac arrest; fainting or severe symptoms require emergency care.

### **Ventricular Assist Device**

A mechanical pump supporting circulation in advanced heart failure. Types include left-, right-, and biventricular devices. Uses may include temporary support, a bridge to transplantation, or long-term therapy; complications include bleeding, infection, stroke, and pump thrombosis.

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### **Ventricular Fibrillation**

Chaotic electrical activity in ventricles, causing no cardiac output. Immediate defibrillation is treatment. Causes: coronary artery disease, cardiomyopathy, electrolyte disturbances, drug toxicity. Post-resuscitation care: targeted temperature management, coronary angiography, ICU admission.

#### **Synonyms:**

V-Fib

### **Ventricular Septal Defect**

An opening in the wall between the ventricles that can allow blood to flow from the left ventricle to the right. The effects depend on the size and location of the defect and may range from no symptoms to heart failure or pulmonary vascular disease.

### **Ventricular Tachycardia**

A wide-complex tachycardia (QRS >0.12 s) originating from the ventricles, with a rate of 100-250 bpm. Monomorphic VT has uniform QRS complexes; polymorphic VT has varying QRS morphology. VT is life-threatening and may degenerate to ventricular fibrillation.

### **Ventriculoatrial**

Relating to or connecting a ventricle of the brain or heart with an atrium; often describing a cerebrospinal-fluid shunt to the right atrium.

### **Ventriculography**

Imaging ventricular function. Radionuclide ventriculography (MUGA scan) accurately measures ejection fraction. Cardiac MRI also accurate.

### **Ventriculoperitoneal Shunt**

A surgically implanted system that drains cerebrospinal fluid from a brain ventricle into the abdominal cavity, where the fluid can be absorbed.

### **Venturi Mask**

Precise FiO<sub>2</sub> delivery. Color-coded adapters.

### **Venule**

A small vessel that drains blood from capillary beds

into veins. Postcapillary venules are important sites for leukocyte migration and inflammatory fluid exchange.

### **Vernal Keratoconjunctivitis**

A recurrent allergic inflammation of the conjunctiva and cornea, usually affecting children or adolescents and causing itching, redness, and light sensitivity.

### **Verruciform Xanthoma**

A rare benign lesion characterized by a verrucous epithelial surface with lipid-laden macrophages in the underlying connective tissue. It most often occurs in oral or genital mucosa and may resemble a wart or malignant lesion clinically.

### **Verrucous Carcinoma**

A low-grade, well-differentiated variant of squamous cell carcinoma with a warty, exophytic appearance. It is locally invasive but rarely metastasizes, commonly affecting the oral cavity, skin, or genitalia.

### **Vertebra**

The individual bone of the vertebral column (33 vertebrae: 7 cervical, 12 thoracic, 5 lumbar, 5 sacral fused, 4 coccygeal). Parts: vertebral body, vertebral arch (pedicles, laminae), spinous and transverse processes, articular processes/facets, and vertebral foramen (spinal canal).

### **Vertebral Canal**

The bony canal formed by the vertebrae that encloses and protects the spinal cord.

### **Vertebral Column**

33 vertebrae: 7 cervical, 12 thoracic, 5 lumbar, 5 fused sacral, 4 fused coccygeal. Protects the spinal cord, supports the head/trunk, provides muscle/rib attachment. Each typical vertebra has a body, vertebral arch, and 7 processes. Intervertebral discs (nucleus pulposus/annulus fibrosus) provide cushioning.

### **Vertebrobasilar Insufficiency**

A condition of reduced blood flow through the ver-



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tebral arteries or basilar artery to the posterior circulation of the brain, including the brainstem, cerebellum, occipital lobes, and thalami.

### **Vertical Talus**

A congenital rigid flatfoot deformity in which the talus is positioned vertically and the midfoot is dorsiflexed. It may be isolated or associated with neuromuscular or genetic syndromes and usually requires early orthopedic assessment and treatment.

### **Vertigo**

A false sensation of rotational or linear movement of the self or the environment, and it is a symptom rather than a disease, requiring differentiation from dizziness, disequilibrium, and presyncope.

### **Vesical**

Relating to bladder. Vesical carcinoma, vesical diverticulum, vesical neck.

### **Vesicovaginal Fistula**

An abnormal connection between the bladder and vagina that causes continuous or frequent leakage of urine through the vagina. It may follow childbirth injury, pelvic surgery, radiation, or advanced infection and usually requires specialist repair.

### **Vesicle**

A small (<1 cm) fluid-filled blister within the epidermis, containing clear fluid (serum) or, if infected, pus. Causes: viral (herpes simplex, herpes zoster, varicella, hand-foot-mouth disease), dermatitis (contact, dyshidrotic eczema), autoimmune (pemphigus, bullous pemphigoid early), and friction burns.

### **Vesicoureteral Reflux**

Retrograde flow of urine from the bladder into the ureters and potentially the kidneys, most commonly due to incompetent ureterovesical valve. Predisposes to pyelonephritis and renal scarring. More common in children, presenting with recurrent febrile UTIs. Diagnosis: voiding cystourethrogram (VCUG). Grading I-V.

#### **Synonyms:**

Reflux, Vesicoureteral

### **Vestibular Migraine**

Episodic vestibular symptoms associated with migraine biology, with or without simultaneous headache. Episodes may include vertigo, motion sensitivity, visual aura, or sound sensitivity; diagnosis is clinical after exclusion of other vestibular and neurologic causes.

### **Vestibular Neuritis**

Acute vestibular dysfunction due to inflammation of the vestibular nerve, typically viral in origin. Presents with acute onset of vertigo, nausea, vomiting, and nystagmus lasting days. Hearing is normal (unlike labyrinthitis). Diagnosis: clinical, HINTS exam (Head Impulse, Nystagmus, Test of Skew) to differentiate from central causes.

### **Vestibular Papillomatosis**

A normal anatomical variant of the female vulva characterised by multiple, soft, finger-like or filiform papules on the labia minora and vestibule, often mistaken for genital warts (condylomata acuminata).

### **Vestibular Rehabilitation**

Exercise-based therapy that improves balance, gaze stability, and adaptation in people with vestibular disorders or dizziness.

### **Vestibular Schwannoma**

A benign, slow-growing tumor of the vestibular portion of the eighth cranial nerve. See Acoustic Neuroma.

### **Vestibule**

Central bony labyrinth between cochlea and semi-circular canals, containing utricle (horizontal linear acceleration and head tilt detection) and saccule (vertical linear acceleration detection). Each has a macula with hair cells covered by gelatinous membrane embedded with otoconia (calcium carbonate crystals).

### **VEXAS Syndrome**

VEXAS (Vacuoles, E1 ubiquitin-activating enzyme, X-linked, Autoinflammatory, Somatic) syndrome is an adult-onset autoinflammatory disorder caused

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by somatic UBA1 mutations in hematopoietic stem cells, affecting men >50.

### **Vibrio Cholerae**

A gram-negative, curved rod that causes cholera, a severe diarrhoeal illness. The organism produces cholera toxin, which causes profuse watery diarrhea (rice-water stools). Transmission occurs through contaminated water and food. The infectious dose varies depending on stomach acidity.

### **Vibrio Vulnificus Infections**

Infections caused by *Vibrio vulnificus*, a gram-negative bacterium found in warm seawater and raw seafood. It can cause wound infection, bloodstream infection, or gastroenteritis, with particularly severe disease in people with chronic liver disease or other risk factors.

### **Video Laryngoscope**

An airway device with a camera near the blade tip that displays the laryngeal view on a monitor. It may improve visualization during tracheal intubation, particularly when direct laryngoscopy is difficult, but does not eliminate aspiration or airway-trauma risk.

### **Video Laryngoscopy**

Video laryngoscopy uses a camera-equipped blade to display an indirect view of the glottis on a screen.

### **Videofluoroscopic Swallow Study**

Real-time X-ray imaging of swallowing. Detailed assessment of oropharyngeal phase.

### **Videostroboscopy**

A diagnostic technique that uses synchronized stroboscopic light to create a slow-motion view of vocal-fold vibration. It assesses the mucosal wave, amplitude, symmetry, and glottic closure.

### **Villous Atrophy**

Flattening and loss of the normal small-intestinal villi, reducing absorptive surface area and occurring in conditions such as coeliac disease.

### **Viral Assembly**

The process of packaging newly synthesised viral genomes and proteins into complete virions. Assembly typically occurs in the nucleus or cytoplasm, depending on the virus type. The process involves self-assembly of capsid proteins around the viral genome.

### **Viral Attachment**

The initial step in viral infection where viral surface proteins bind to specific receptors on host cells. Attachment determines viral tropism and host range. The viral attachment protein is called the ligand, and the host cell receptor is typically a protein or glycan.

### **Viral Conjunctivitis**

The most common form of infectious conjunctivitis, caused predominantly by adenoviruses (serotypes 3, 4, 7, 8, 19, and 37), and it is highly contagious, spreading through direct contact with infected ocular secretions or contaminated surfaces.

### **Viral Culture**

Growth of a virus in susceptible cell cultures to identify an infectious agent. It can be useful for selected viruses, but molecular and antigen-based tests are often faster or more sensitive; the appropriate method depends on the suspected infection and specimen.

### **Viral Cytopathic Effects**

Observable changes in host cells caused by viral infection. CPE include cell rounding, detachment, syncytia formation (fusion of infected cells), inclusion bodies, and cell lysis. CPE are used in viral diagnosis and can be observed by light microscopy.

### **Viral Entry**

The process by which viruses cross the host cell membrane to deliver their genome into the cytoplasm. Entry occurs through membrane fusion (enveloped viruses) or endocytosis (enveloped and non-enveloped viruses). For membrane fusion, viral fusion proteins mediate merger of the viral envelope with the host cell membrane.

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## **Viral Gastroenteritis**

Inflammation of the stomach or intestines caused by a virus. Common symptoms include watery diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal cramps, and fever. Diagnosis is usually clinical; stool testing is reserved for selected situations. Treatment focuses on fluid replacement and symptom control.

## **Viral Hepatitis**

Inflammation of the liver caused by viral infections. The major hepatitis viruses include A, B, C, D, and E. Hepatitis A and E are transmitted through the fecal-oral route and cause acute, self-limited infections.

### **Synonyms:**

Infectious Hepatitis

## **Viral Immune Evasion**

Mechanisms by which viruses evade host immune responses. Strategies include antigenic variation, inhibition of interferon signalling, downregulation of MHC molecules, and encoding viral homologues of cytokines. Understanding viral immune evasion is essential for developing effective vaccines and antiviral therapies.

## **Viral Infections**

Illnesses caused by viruses, which are intracellular pathogens that hijack host cellular machinery to replicate. They range from self-limited conditions such as the common cold and gastroenteritis to serious diseases including influenza, hepatitis, HIV, and COVID-19.

## **Viral Latency**

A state in which viral genomes persist in host cells without producing infectious particles. Latent viruses can reactivate under certain conditions including immunosuppression. Herpesviruses establish latent infections in specific cell types (HSV in neurons, EBV in B cells, CMV in myeloid cells).

## **Viral Latency Mechanisms**

The strategies by which viruses establish and maintain latent infections. Herpesviruses maintain their genomes as episomes in the nucleus. HIV integrates

into the host genome as a provirus. Latent viruses express minimal proteins to avoid immune detection. Reactivation can be triggered by immunosuppression, stress, or other stimuli.

## **Viral Load (HIV RNA)**

The amount of HIV RNA in plasma, measured by a laboratory assay. It is used to assess viral replication and response to antiretroviral therapy. An undetectable result indicates that the amount is below the assay's reporting limit; testing intervals and treatment decisions follow current clinical guidance.

### **Synonyms:**

HIV RNA

## **Viral Meningitis**

Inflammation of the meninges caused by viruses, usually Enteroviruses. Presents similarly to bacterial meningitis but generally less severe. CSF shows lymphocytic pleocytosis, normal glucose, and mildly elevated protein. Self-limited in most cases; supportive treatment.

## **Viral Pathogenesis**

The mechanisms by which viruses cause disease. Pathogenesis involves attachment, entry, replication, and spread within the host. Viral damage can be direct (cytopathic effects) or indirect (immune-mediated). Direct effects include cell death, altered cell function, and cell transformation.

## **Viral Pneumonia**

Infection and inflammation of lung tissue caused by a virus, producing cough, fever, chills, breathlessness, chest discomfort, fatigue, and variable impairment of oxygenation. Severe disease can cause respiratory failure or secondary bacterial infection.

## **Viral Release**

The process by which newly assembled virions exit the host cell to infect other cells. Release occurs through budding (enveloped viruses) or cell lysis (non-enveloped viruses). Budding allows the virus to acquire an envelope from host cell membranes without killing the cell.

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## **Viral Replication**

The process of synthesising new viral genomes and proteins within host cells. The mechanism varies by virus type. DNA viruses typically replicate in the nucleus using host cell DNA polymerases (except poxviruses). RNA viruses typically replicate in the cytoplasm using viral RNA-dependent RNA polymerase.

## **Viral Replication Cycle**

The series of steps by which viruses reproduce within host cells.

## **Viral Structure**

The basic components of viral particles (virions). Viruses consist of a nucleic acid genome (DNA or RNA) surrounded by a protein coat called a capsid. Some viruses have an outer lipid envelope derived from host cell membranes. The capsid is composed of structural units called capsomeres.

## **Viral Uncoating**

The process by which the viral capsid is disassembled to release the viral genome into the host cell cytoplasm. Uncoating occurs after entry and before replication. The mechanism varies by virus type and can involve pH-dependent conformational changes, proteolytic cleavage, or disassembly of capsid proteins.

## **Virchow's Triad**

Virchow's triad describes three broad categories of factors that contribute to thrombosis: endothelial injury or dysfunction, stasis or turbulent blood flow, and hypercoagulability. Endothelial injury exposes subendothelial collagen and tissue factor, initiating platelet adhesion and the coagulation cascade.

## **Viremia**

The presence of virus in the bloodstream. Viremia may be transient or persistent and can enable dissemination to target organs; it may be detected by culture, antigen testing, or nucleic-acid amplification.

## **Virilisation**

The development of male secondary sexual characteristics in females, resulting from excessive androgen production or exposure.

## **Virilism Foetal**

Prenatal or neonatal masculinization of a genetically female fetus or infant due to excess androgen exposure. Causes include congenital adrenal hyperplasia, maternal androgen-producing disease, or placental and fetal steroidogenic disorders.

## **Virology**

The branch of microbiology concerned with viruses: structure, classification (DNA/RNA, enveloped/nonenveloped, Baltimore scheme), replication, pathogenesis, epidemiology, diagnosis, treatment, and prevention. Diagnostic methods: cell culture, antigen detection, nucleic acid amplification (PCR), and serology (IgM/IgG).

## **Virulence**

The relative capacity of a microorganism to cause disease or tissue injury in a host. It depends on microbial factors such as toxins, adhesins, invasiveness, and immune evasion, together with host susceptibility.

## **Virulence Factor**

A microbial product or characteristic that helps an organism colonize, evade host defenses, injure tissue, or otherwise cause disease. Examples include adhesins, toxins, capsules, enzymes, and mechanisms that alter immune recognition.

## **Viscera**

The internal organs of the body, particularly those within the thoracic and abdominal cavities. The thoracic viscera include the heart, lungs, esophagus, trachea, and thymus.

## **Vision**

The sensory ability to perceive light and interpret visual information processed by the eyes and brain, enabling recognition of shapes, colors, depth, and motion. Normal vision depends on the proper func-

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tion of the cornea, lens, retina, and optic nerve, as well as intact neural pathways to the visual cortex.

### **Vision And Hearing**

The two primary sensory modalities through which humans perceive and interact with their environment. Age-related declines in both senses are common, with presbyopia and cataracts affecting vision and presbycusis affecting hearing, often beginning as early as the fourth decade of life.

### **Vision Impairment**

Reduced visual acuity or visual-field function that affects daily activities. Causes include refractive error, cataract, glaucoma, retinal disease, optic-nerve injury, and neurologic disease. Evaluation and treatment depend on the cause; rehabilitation and visual aids may improve function.

### **Vision, Blurred**

Reduced sharpness or clarity of vision that may result from refractive error, dry eye, cataract, retinal or optic-nerve disease, neurologic disease, medication, or other causes. Sudden, painful, one-sided, or progressive blurring requires prompt evaluation.

### **Vision Loss, Acute**

Sudden reduction or loss of vision in one or both eyes caused by retinal vascular occlusion, retinal detachment, optic-nerve disease, stroke, acute glaucoma, inflammation, trauma, or other emergency. It requires immediate medical or ophthalmic assessment.

### **Vision Loss**

A decrease in the ability to see that cannot be fully corrected with eyeglasses, contact lenses, or medical treatment. It ranges from partial impairment to complete blindness and can result from conditions such as macular degeneration, glaucoma, diabetic retinopathy, cataracts, and traumatic injury.

### **Vision Problems**

Changes in visual acuity, field, color, or clarity caused by refractive error, eye disease, neurologic disease, or systemic illness. Sudden vision loss is an

emergency.

### **Vision Screening**

Screening for visual problems in children: newborn—red reflex examination (cataract, retinoblastoma); 3-5 years—visual acuity, strabismus screening (cover test, photostrengthening), and amblyopia risk factors.

### **Visual Acuity**

The resolving power of the eye, defined as the ability to distinguish two points as distinct, and the most common clinical measure of visual function.

### **Visual Agnosia**

Inability to recognize or identify visually presented objects, faces, or symbols despite adequate vision and attention. It results from dysfunction of higher-order visual association cortex and may follow stroke, trauma, neurodegenerative disease, or other brain injury.

### **Visual Field Defect**

Loss or alteration of a portion of the normally perceived visual field caused by dysfunction of the retina, optic nerve, chiasm, optic tract, radiations, or visual cortex. The pattern can help localize the lesion.

### **Visual Field Perimetry**

A systematic method of measuring the sensitivity of the retina across the entire visual field using standardized light stimuli, providing a quantitative map of visual function that can detect, characterize, and monitor visual field loss caused by diseases of the retina, optic nerve, and visual pathways.

### **Visual Impairment**

Reduced vision that cannot be fully corrected by ordinary glasses or contact lenses. Causes include refractive error, cataract, glaucoma, retinal disease, optic-nerve injury, and neurologic disease; new or sudden loss of vision requires urgent assessment.



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## Vital Signs

Basic measurements of physiologic status, commonly including temperature, pulse, respiratory rate, blood pressure, and oxygen saturation. Values vary with age, activity, illness, and measurement conditions; trends and clinical context are important.

## Vitamin A Deficiency

A nutritional disorder resulting from inadequate intake or absorption of retinol, causing xerophthalmia, night blindness, follicular hyperkeratosis, and impaired immunity. Severe deficiency leads to corneal ulceration and blindness, and is a leading cause of preventable childhood blindness worldwide.

## Vitamin A: Retinal

Vitamin A (retinol) is a fat-soluble vitamin essential for vision, immune function, cell differentiation, and reproduction. In the eye, retinol is oxidized to retinal (retinaldehyde), which binds to opsin in the photoreceptor outer segments forming rhodopsin (in rods) and photopsins (in cones).

## Vitamin B Complex

A group of eight water-soluble vitamins that support energy metabolism, blood-cell production, nervous-system function, and other biochemical processes. The group includes vitamins B1 through B7 and B9, as well as vitamin B12.

## Vitamin B1 (Thiamine)

Water-soluble vitamin, coenzyme in carbohydrate metabolism. Deficiency: beriberi (wet, dry), Wernicke-Korsakoff. Risk: alcoholism, bariatric surgery, dialysis. Treatment: supplementation.

### Synonyms:

Thiamine

## Vitamin B12 (Cobalamin)

Required for nerve function, red blood cell formation, DNA synthesis. Deficiency: megaloblastic anemia, neurological damage. Risk: vegans, elderly, pernicious anemia, metformin use, bariatric surgery. Requires intrinsic factor for absorption.

### Synonyms:

Cobalamin

## Vitamin B12 Deficiency

Megaloblastic anemia, neurological symptoms. Pernicious anemia, vegan diet. Treated with B12 supplementation.

## Vitamin B12 Deficiency In Older Adults

Deficiency caused by inadequate intake, malabsorption, autoimmune intrinsic-factor deficiency, gastric surgery, or medications. It may cause megaloblastic anemia, neuropathy, cognitive changes, gait impairment, and glossitis; neurologic injury can occur without anemia.

## Vitamin B12: Cobalamin

A water-soluble vitamin needed for red-blood-cell formation, DNA synthesis, and normal nerve function. Deficiency can cause megaloblastic anemia and neurologic abnormalities.

## Vitamin B1: Thiamine

A water-soluble vitamin that acts as a cofactor in carbohydrate and amino-acid metabolism and supports nerve function. Severe deficiency can cause beriberi or Wernicke-Korsakoff syndrome.

## Vitamin B2 (Riboflavin)

Precursor for FAD and FMN. Deficiency: cheilosis, glossitis, seborrheic dermatitis. Common with B-complex deficiency.

### Synonyms:

Riboflavin

## Vitamin B3 (Niacin)

Precursor for NAD<sup>+</sup> and NADP<sup>+</sup>. Deficiency: pellagra (diarrhea, dermatitis, dementia). Sources: meat, fish, poultry, grains.

### Synonyms:

Niacin

## Vitamin B3: Niacin

A water-soluble vitamin that forms the coenzymes NAD and NADP, which participate in many oxidation-reduction and energy-producing reactions.



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Severe deficiency causes pellagra.

### **Vitamin B5 (Pantothenic Acid)**

Component of coenzyme A. Deficiency rare. Involved in fatty acid metabolism.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pantothenic Acid

### **Vitamin B6 (Pyridoxine)**

Coenzyme in amino acid metabolism. Deficiency: seizures, anemia, dermatitis. Risk: isoniazid therapy, alcoholism.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pyridoxine

### **Vitamin B6: Pyridoxine**

Pyridoxine (pyridoxal phosphate, PLP, the active form) is a water-soluble B vitamin essential as a co-factor for over 100 enzymatic reactions, particularly in amino acid metabolism.

### **Vitamin B7 (Biotin)**

Coenzyme for carboxylation reactions. Deficiency rare, may occur with raw egg consumption (avidin binds biotin).

#### **Synonyms:**

Biotin

### **Vitamin B9 (Folate)**

Essential for DNA synthesis, red blood cell formation. Deficiency: megaloblastic anemia, neural tube defects in pregnancy. Sources: leafy greens, legumes, fortified grains. Supplementation recommended before and during pregnancy.

#### **Synonyms:**

Folate

### **Vitamin B9: Folate**

Folate (folic acid, tetrahydrofolate/THF) is a water-soluble B vitamin essential for one-carbon transfer reactions in nucleotide synthesis (thymidylate synthesis for DNA, purine synthesis), amino acid metabolism (methionine synthesis from homocysteine), and methylation reactions.

### **Vitamin C (Ascorbic Acid)**

A water-soluble vitamin and a powerful antioxidant, essential for collagen synthesis (required for proline and lysine hydroxylation in collagen triple helix formation), carnitine synthesis, neurotransmitter synthesis (dopamine to norepinephrine), and iron absorption (reduces ferric to ferrous iron in the gut).

#### **Synonyms:**

Ascorbic Acid

### **Vitamin D Deficiency**

Inadequate vitamin-D status causing impaired calcium and phosphate homeostasis and, in severe cases, defective bone mineralization. It may result from low exposure or intake, malabsorption, liver or kidney disease, or altered metabolism.

### **Vitamin D: Calcitriol**

Vitamin D is a fat-soluble vitamin (actually a pro-hormone) essential for calcium and phosphorus homeostasis and bone health. Cholecalciferol (D3) is synthesized in the skin from 7-dehydrocholesterol by UVB radiation, or obtained from diet (ergocalciferol/D2 from plants, D3 from animal sources).

### **Vitamin E: Tocopherol**

Vitamin E (alpha-tocopherol) is a fat-soluble vitamin and the body's primary lipid-soluble antioxidant, protecting polyunsaturated fatty acids in cell membranes from lipid peroxidation by free radicals (reactive oxygen species). It donates a hydrogen atom to lipid peroxyl radicals, breaking the chain reaction of lipid peroxidation.

### **Vitamin K Deficiency**

Coagulopathy, bleeding. Newborns receive prophylaxis. Antibiotics can cause deficiency.

### **Vitamin K Prophylaxis**

Administration of vitamin K to a newborn soon after birth to prevent vitamin K deficiency

### **Vaccinia**

The orthopoxvirus used in the smallpox vaccine; infection is uncommon and may cause a localized

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or disseminated lesion, especially in people with impaired immunity.

### **Vacuole**

A membrane-bound compartment within a cell containing fluid, solutes, or cellular material. Vacuoles have specialized roles in storage, transport, and degradation and may enlarge or accumulate material during disease.

### **Vacuum Extractor**

A cup-shaped device applied to the fetal scalp to assist vaginal delivery when specific maternal or fetal indications are present.

### **Vagus**

Relating to the vagus nerve, the tenth cranial nerve, which carries parasympathetic, sensory, and motor fibers between the brainstem and thoracic and abdominal organs.

### **Valgus**

A deformity in which the distal part of a limb deviates away from the body's midline; examples include hallux valgus and genu valgum.

### **Validity**

The extent to which a test or measurement accurately assesses what it is intended to assess.

### **Valine**

An essential branched-chain amino acid required for protein synthesis and metabolism.

### **Valves**

Flap-like structures that permit fluid or blood to move preferentially in one direction, including cardiac and venous valves.

### **Valvotomy**

Surgical or catheter-based division of narrowed valve tissue to improve blood flow, most often performed for selected stenotic heart valves.

### **Valvular Disease**

Disease affecting one or more heart valves, causing stenosis, regurgitation, or both and potentially leading to heart failure or arrhythmia.

### **Vancomycin**

A glycopeptide antibiotic that inhibits Gram-positive bacterial cell-wall synthesis. It is given intravenously for serious resistant infections and orally for *C. difficile* colitis; infusion reactions, nephrotoxicity, and ototoxicity require caution.

### **Van Den Bergh Test**

A historical test measuring the reaction of serum bilirubin with a diazo reagent to help distinguish conjugated from unconjugated hyperbilirubinemia.

### **Vaporiser**

A device that converts a liquid medicine or volatile substance into a vapor for inhalation or controlled delivery, such as in anesthesia.

### **Variance**

A statistical measure of dispersion equal to the average squared deviation from the mean.

### **Varix**

An abnormally dilated, tortuous vein; multiple varices commonly occur in portal hypertension or chronic venous disease.

### **Varus**

A deformity in which the distal part of a limb deviates toward the body's midline; examples include genu varum and talipes equinovarus.

### **Vas**

A duct or vessel; in reproductive anatomy, the vas deferens transports sperm from the epididymis toward the ejaculatory duct.

### **Vasa Efferentia**

Small ducts carrying sperm from the rete testis to the epididymal duct.

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### **Vasoconstriction**

Source spelling variant of *vasoconstriction*, the narrowing of a blood vessel caused by contraction of its muscular wall.

### **Vasoconstrictors**

Substances or medicines that narrow blood vessels and usually increase vascular resistance and blood pressure.

### **Vasomotor Centre**

Brainstem networks, chiefly in the medulla, that regulate vascular tone and contribute to control of blood pressure.

### **Vasomotor Nerves**

Autonomic nerves that alter blood-vessel diameter by causing vascular smooth-muscle contraction or relaxation.

### **Vasopressin**

Antidiuretic hormone, also called arginine vasopressin, which promotes renal water reabsorption and can constrict blood vessels.

### **Vasovagal Attack**

A transient reflex episode caused by reduced sympathetic tone and increased vagal activity, producing hypotension and often bradycardia with fainting or near-fainting. Common triggers include prolonged standing, pain, fear, heat, dehydration, or emotional stress.

### **VD**

Abbreviation for venereal disease, an older term for a sexually transmitted infection.

### **Veganism**

A dietary or lifestyle pattern that excludes animal-derived foods; nutritional adequacy requires attention to nutrients such as vitamin B12, iron, calcium, iodine, and omega-3 fatty acids.

### **Vegetarianism**

A dietary pattern that excludes meat, with inclusion

or exclusion of eggs and dairy depending on the subtype; nutritional planning may be needed.

### **Vegetations**

Abnormal masses, often composed of fibrin, platelets, and microorganisms, that form on heart valves in infective endocarditis; sterile vegetations can occur in other conditions.

### **Vehicle**

A substance or medium that carries an active medicine, microorganism, or toxic agent; in pharmacology it may be the inactive base in which a drug is formulated.

### **Veins**

Blood vessels that return blood toward the heart. Most carry deoxygenated blood, while pulmonary and umbilical veins carry oxygenated blood.

### **Veins, Diseases Of**

Disorders including thrombosis, varicose veins, chronic venous insufficiency, venous ulcers, inflammation, and congenital venous malformations.

### **Venepuncture**

Puncture of a vein with a needle to obtain blood or establish intravenous access.

### **Venesection**

The controlled removal of blood from a vein, used diagnostically or therapeutically, for example in selected cases of hemochromatosis or polycythemia.

### **Ventilation, Artificial**

Mechanical movement of air into and out of the lungs using a device when spontaneous breathing is inadequate or absent.

### **Ventouse**

A vacuum extractor used for selected assisted vaginal deliveries.

### **Ventricular Hypertrophy**

Thickening of a heart-ventricle wall, usually from

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chronic pressure or volume overload, inherited cardiomyopathy, or athletic adaptation. It may cause diastolic dysfunction, arrhythmia, ischemia, or heart failure.

### **Ventrosuspension**

Surgical fixation of a displaced or prolapsed uterus to the anterior abdominal wall or nearby supporting tissues.

### **Verapamil**

A non-dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker used for selected hypertension, angina, and supraventricular tachyarrhythmias; it can cause bradycardia and constipation.

### **Vermicides**

Medicines or chemical agents that kill parasitic worms; the appropriate agent depends on the parasite and site of infection.

### **Vernix**

A white, greasy protective coating on the skin of a fetus or newborn, composed mainly of water, lipids, and shed skin cells.

### **Verrucose**

Having a rough, wart-like, or papillated surface.

### **Vertebrobasilar Insufficiency**

Source spelling variant of *vertebrobasilar insufficiency*, reduced blood flow in the vertebral or basilar circulation supplying the brainstem, cerebellum, and posterior brain.

### **Vesicants**

Substances that cause blistering and tissue injury on contact; examples include certain chemotherapy agents and chemical-warfare agents.

### **Vesico-Ureteric Reflux**

Backward flow of urine from the bladder into one or both ureters and sometimes the kidneys, increasing the risk of recurrent urinary infection and renal scarring.

### **Vesicular Breathing**

The normal soft, rustling breath sound heard over most peripheral lung fields during auscultation.

### **Vestibulo-Ocular Reflex**

A reflex that moves the eyes opposite to head movement, stabilizing visual fixation during motion through signals from the vestibular system.

### **Vestigial**

Describing a structure or feature that has become greatly reduced through evolution and has little or no apparent original function.

### **Vibrator**

A device that produces mechanical vibration and may be used for sexual stimulation, therapeutic massage, or selected rehabilitation purposes.

### **Vibrio**

A genus of curved, Gram-negative bacteria; species include *V. cholerae*, which causes cholera, and *V. vulnificus*, which can cause severe wound or bloodstream infection.

### **Villus**

A small finger-like projection, especially one of the intestinal mucosa that increases absorptive surface area; chorionic villi mediate exchange between placenta and fetus.

### **Vinca Alkaloids**

Anticancer medicines, including vincristine and vinblastine, that inhibit microtubule formation and cell division.

### **Vincent's Angina**

Acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis or tonsillitis associated with fusiform bacteria and spirochetes, causing painful ulcers, bleeding, and fetid breath.

### **Vinorelbine**

A semisynthetic vinca-alkaloid chemotherapy medicine used primarily for selected lung and breast cancers; myelosuppression is a major adverse effect.

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## **Viraemia**

The presence of viruses in the bloodstream, which may be transient or persistent and may permit spread to distant tissues.

## **Viral Haemorrhagic Fever**

A severe illness caused by certain viruses that may produce fever, vascular injury, thrombocytopenia, and bleeding; severity and transmission vary by virus.

## **Virilism**

Development of masculinizing features in a female, usually from excess androgen exposure or production, such as hirsutism, deep voice, acne, and menstrual disturbance.

## **Virus**

An infectious agent consisting of genetic material enclosed in a protein coat, sometimes with a lipid envelope, that replicates only inside living host cells. Newborns have limited vitamin K stores, so the recommended route and dose are chosen according to local guidance and the infant's clinical circumstances.

## **Vitamin K: Phylloquinone**

Vitamin K is a fat-soluble vitamin essential for the post-translational gamma-carboxylation of glutamate residues to gamma-carboxyglutamate (Gla) in specific clotting factors (II, VII, IX, X, protein C, protein S) and anticoagulant proteins (protein C, protein S, protein Z).

## **Vitamins**

A biological substance or process involving vitamins; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

## **Vitrectomy**

Surgical removal of the vitreous gel, typically via the pars plana approach, using a cutting probe under microscopic visualization. Indications include vitreous hemorrhage, complicated retinal detachment, macular holes, epiretinal membranes, intraocular foreign bodies, and endophthalmitis.

## **Vitreous Chemistry**

Analysis of the fluid from the eye after death for substances such as electrolytes, glucose, urea, creatinine, and ethanol. It may support assessment of postmortem interval or metabolic disturbance but is not independently diagnostic of cause or time of death.

## **Vitreous Hemorrhage**

Bleeding into the vitreous cavity that causes sudden painless floaters, cobwebs, haze, or loss of vision. Common causes include proliferative diabetic retinopathy, retinal tear or detachment, trauma, and posterior vitreous separation.

## **Vitreous Humor**

The clear gel that fills the space between the lens and retina. It helps maintain the shape of the eye and transmits light to the retina.

## **VLDL**

Very low-density lipoprotein. Transports endogenous triglycerides.

## **Vocal Cord Nodules**

Benign, usually paired thickened areas of the vocal folds caused by repeated voice strain or overuse. They can cause hoarseness, vocal fatigue, and a rough or breathy voice.

## **Vocal Cord Paralysis**

Immobility of one or both vocal cords due to disruption of the recurrent laryngeal nerve (RLN). Unilateral vocal cord paralysis: hoarseness, breathy voice, aspiration, and ineffective cough.

### **Synonyms:**

Vocal Fold Paralysis

## **Vocal Cord Paresis**

Partial paralysis or weakness of one or both vocal cords due to impaired function of the recurrent laryngeal nerve (RLN) or the vagus nerve. Unilateral paresis is more common and presents with hoarseness, breathy dysphonia, vocal fatigue, and sometimes aspiration.

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### Vocal Cord Polyp

Vocal cord polyps are benign, unilateral, sessile or pedunculated lesions that arise from the vocal cord mucosa, typically as a result of a single traumatic vocal event such as shouting, screaming, or coughing, causing hemorrhage and edema in the superficial lamina propria (Reinke space).

### Vocal Folds

Paired mucosal folds within the larynx that vibrate as air passes between them to produce sound. They also close to protect the airway and assist in raising intrathoracic pressure.

### Vocal Resonance

The transmission of vocal sounds to the chest wall, assessed by having the patient speak while auscultating. It is increased in consolidation and decreased in pleural effusion or pneumothorax. It correlates with bronchophony and whispered pectoriloquy.

### Vocal-Cord Dysfunction

Episodic inappropriate adduction of the vocal folds, especially during inspiration, causing throat tightness, noisy breathing, and apparent asthma-like attacks. Diagnosis is supported by laryngoscopy during symptoms; speech therapy and trigger management are central treatments.

### Voice And Speech

The products of complex coordinated activity of the respiratory, laryngeal, and articulatory systems.

### Voiding Cystourethrogram

Fluoroscopic imaging of the bladder and urethra during voiding, after filling the bladder with contrast via a catheter. Indications: evaluation of vesicoureteral reflux (VUR) in children with recurrent UTIs, posterior urethral valves in males, and post-surgical assessment of the bladder/urethra.

### Volatile Anesthetics

Halogenated inhaled anesthetic agents, including sevoflurane, desflurane, and isoflurane, that reversibly depress central nervous system function. They provide dose-dependent hypnosis and immo-

bility but may cause hypotension, respiratory depression, postoperative nausea, and malignant hyperthermia in susceptible individuals.

### Volume Of Distribution

A theoretical pharmacokinetic parameter that relates the total amount of drug in the body to the plasma concentration, calculated as  $V_d$  equals amount of drug in the body divided by plasma concentration. It represents the apparent volume into which a drug distributes and is not a true anatomical volume.

### Volutrauma

Lung injury caused by excessive mechanical stretch, usually from an inappropriately large tidal volume during ventilation. Risk is reduced by lung-protective ventilation tailored to the patient's predicted body weight, lung mechanics, and clinical condition.

### Volvulus

Twisting of a loop of intestine around its mesenteric attachment point causing luminal obstruction and compromise of the mesenteric blood supply which can rapidly progress to bowel ischemia.

### Vomiting

Reflex expulsion of gastric contents. Causes: GI, neurological, metabolic, toxic, psychological. Treatment: antiemetics, identify cause, prevent aspiration.

### Von Hippel-Lindau Disease

Autosomal dominant syndrome caused by mutations in the VHL tumor suppressor gene on chromosome three predisposing to hemangioblastomas of the central nervous system and retina, clear cell renal cell carcinoma, pheochromocytoma, pancreatic cysts and neuroendocrine tumors, and endolymphatic sac tumors.

### Von Willebrand Disease

An inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by deficient or abnormal von Willebrand factor, which helps platelets adhere and carries factor VIII. It



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commonly causes nosebleeds, easy bruising, heavy menstrual bleeding, or prolonged bleeding after procedures.

### **Voriconazole**

A triazole antifungal agent used in the treatment of invasive aspergillosis, candidemia, and other serious fungal infections. Voriconazole inhibits the fungal cytochrome P450 enzyme lanosterol 14-alpha demethylase, preventing ergosterol synthesis and disrupting fungal cell membrane integrity.

### **Voyeuristic Disorder**

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent, intense sexual arousal from observing an unsuspecting person who is naked, disrobing, or engaging in sexual activity. The individual has acted on these urges or they cause marked distress or interpersonal difficulty. Duration  $\geq 6$  months. Most common in males with onset in adolescence.

### **VRE**

Enterococcus bacteria that are resistant to vancomycin, often because of acquired changes in cell-wall precursors. VRE can cause urinary, bloodstream, wound, or other healthcare-associated infections. Treatment requires susceptibility-guided selection of an effective antimicrobial and source control when needed.

### **Vulvitis**

Inflammation of the vulva (external female genitalia), often presenting with pruritus, burning, irritation, erythema, edema, and discharge. Vulvitis is rarely isolated and is most commonly part of vulvovaginitis (inflammation of both vulva and vagina).

### **Vulvodynia**

Vulvodynia is chronic vulvar pain without an identifiable specific cause, often described as burning or rawness and triggered by touch, pressure, or occurring spontaneously.

#### **Synonyms:**

Chronic Vulvar Pain

### **Vulvovaginal Candidiasis**

Symptomatic infection of the vulva and vagina, usually caused by *Candida albicans*. Pruritus, soreness, erythema, and thick discharge are common; diagnosis is clinical with microscopy or culture when recurrent, severe, atypical, or treatment-resistant.

### **Vagal Paraganglioma**

A usually slow-growing tumor arising from paraganglion cells near the vagus nerve in the neck.

### **Vaginal Agenesis**

A condition in which the vagina is absent or incompletely developed.

### **Vaginal Atrophy**

Thinning, drying, and inflammation of vaginal tissues caused by reduced estrogen.

### **Vaginal Fistula**

An abnormal opening connecting the vagina to another organ, such as the bladder or rectum.

### **Vertebral Tumor**

A tumor arising in or near a vertebra of the spinal column.

### **Vagotomy**

Surgical cutting of selected vagus-nerve branches, historically used to reduce stomach acid secretion.

### **Vascular System**

The network of arteries, veins, and capillaries that transports blood through the body.

### **Vaginal Speculum**

An instrument inserted into the vagina to separate its walls and permit examination of the vagina and cervix or collection of specimens.

### **Vernix Caseosa**

A white, greasy protective coating on the skin of a fetus or newborn, composed mainly of water, lipids, and shed skin cells.

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### **Vestibulocochlear Nerve**

The eighth cranial nerve, carrying information for hearing and balance from the inner ear to the brain.

### **Vibrios**

Comma-shaped bacteria, usually Gram-negative, that include species capable of causing cholera and wound or gastrointestinal infections.

### **Villi**

Finger-like projections that increase the absorptive surface of the small-intestinal lining; similar structures occur in the placenta and other tissues.

### **Vincent Disease**

Acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis associated with fusospirochetal bacteria, causing painful bleeding gums, ulceration, and foul breath.

### **Vision Receptors**

Photoreceptors in the retina, mainly rods and cones, that convert light into neural signals.

### **Vaginal Hematoma**

A collection of blood within the vaginal wall or surrounding tissues, usually caused by childbirth, trauma, or surgery and potentially producing severe pain, swelling, or blood loss.

### **Vertebral Compression Fracture**

Collapse of a vertebral body, often caused by osteoporosis, trauma, or malignancy, producing back pain, loss of height, or progressive kyphosis.

### **Veno-Occlusive Disease**

Obstruction of small veins, particularly in the liver after certain chemotherapy or hematopoietic stem-cell transplantation, causing painful hepatomegaly, fluid retention, jaundice, and weight gain.

### **Vaginal Intraepithelial Neoplasia**

Precancerous abnormal growth of squamous cells in the vaginal epithelium, usually associated with human papillomavirus and graded according to the severity of dysplasia.

### **Vitreous Detachment**

Separation of the vitreous gel from the retina, usually related to aging and often causing new floaters or flashes. Sudden symptoms require assessment for retinal tears or detachment.

### **Viral Exanthem**

A widespread skin eruption caused by a viral infection, often accompanied by fever or other systemic symptoms.

### **Valvuloplasty**

A procedure used to widen or repair a narrowed or abnormal heart valve, by balloon catheter or open surgery depending on the valve and condition.

### **Valvulotomy**

Surgical incision of a stenosed heart valve to improve the opening through which blood flows.

### **Varices**

Abnormally dilated and tortuous veins, commonly occurring in the legs or in the oesophagus and stomach as a result of portal hypertension.

### **Vasodilatation**

Widening of blood vessels caused by relaxation of vascular smooth muscle, increasing blood flow and potentially lowering blood pressure.

### **Vasomotor**

Relating to the control of blood-vessel diameter by nerves, hormones, and local chemical factors.

### **Vasopressor**

An agent or physiological signal that raises blood pressure mainly by constricting blood vessels and sometimes by increasing cardiac activity.

### **Venous Pressure**

The pressure within the venous circulation, influenced by blood volume, venous tone, and the function of the right side of the heart.

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## Ventilation

Movement of air into and out of the lungs; effective ventilation brings oxygen to the alveoli and removes carbon dioxide.

## Vesicoureteric Reflux

Backward flow of urine from the bladder into one or both ureters and sometimes the kidneys, increasing the risk of urinary infection and renal scarring.

## Visual Fields

The total area that can be seen while the eyes are fixed in one position; defects may indicate retinal, optic-nerve, or brain disease.

## Vital Capacity

The largest volume of air that can be exhaled after a maximal inhalation, equal to inspiratory reserve volume plus tidal volume plus expiratory reserve volume.

## Voice

Sound produced by vibration of the vocal folds as air passes through the larynx, then shaped by the throat, mouth, and nose for speech.

## Vulvectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the vulva, performed for selected cancers, precancerous lesions, or severe persistent disease.

## Vaccine Adjuvant

A substance added to some vaccines to enhance and prolong the immune response to the antigen. Examples include aluminum salts and newer adjuvant systems.

## Vaccine Development

The research and testing process used to create a vaccine, including antigen selection, laboratory studies, clinical trials, manufacturing, safety monitoring, and regulatory review.

## Vaccine Therapy

vaccine therapy is used in relation to vaccine therapy

during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Vaccinia Virus

vaccinia virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

## Vacuum Curettage

A procedure that removes tissue from the uterus using suction, commonly for uterine evacuation or endometrial sampling. Risks include bleeding, infection, retained tissue, and rarely uterine injury.

## Vadimezan

An investigational vascular-disrupting and tumor-necrosis-factor-inducing compound studied as an anticancer agent. It is not an established routine treatment and has no general clinical indication.

## Vagina Carcinoma

A malignant neoplasm arising from the vaginal epithelium; it may present with abnormal bleeding, discharge, or a visible lesion and requires evaluation for local and regional spread.

## Vagina Neoplasm

A tumor arising in the vagina; diagnosis determines whether it is benign or malignant, its tissue type, extent, and appropriate management.

## Vaginectomy

vaginectomy is used in relation to vaginectomy during assessment, diagnosis, treatment, monitoring, or patient support.

## Valacyclovir

Valacyclovir is the oral prodrug of acyclovir that inhibits herpesvirus DNA polymerase after activation; it treats herpes simplex and shingles, with renal dosing and neurotoxicity risk in accumulation.

## Valganciclovir

Valganciclovir is the oral prodrug of ganciclovir used

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mainly to treat or prevent cytomegalovirus infection after transplantation; myelosuppression, renal toxicity, infertility, and teratogenicity are important risks.

### **Valinomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called valinomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Valproic Acid**

valproic acid is a fatty acid or other lipid-related molecule whose chain structure influences membranes, energy storage, signaling, and metabolism.

### **Valrubicin**

An anthracycline antineoplastic drug administered into the bladder for selected cases of carcinoma in situ that have not responded adequately to intravesical bacillus Calmette–Guérin. It can irritate the bladder and may cause systemic toxicity.

### **Valsartan**

Valsartan is an angiotensin-II receptor blocker used for hypertension, heart failure, and selected cardiovascular indications; hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, hypotension, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

### **Vandetanib**

Vandetanib is a tyrosine-kinase inhibitor targeting RET, VEGFR, and EGFR, used for selected medullary thyroid cancers; diarrhoea, hypertension, skin effects, and QT prolongation require monitoring.

### **Varibaculum**

A genus of bacteria in the family Lachnospiraceae, identified mainly in microbiologic and genomic research. Its clinical significance depends on the species and clinical specimen.

### **Varibaculum Cambriense**

A bacterial species in the genus *Varibaculum* re-

ported from human clinical specimens. Its role may be opportunistic and requires identification with the clinical context and susceptibility data.

### **Varicellovirus**

varicellovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Vasculostatin**

Vasculostatin is an experimental anti-angiogenic fragment related to angiostatin that has been studied for inhibition of new blood-vessel growth; it is not an established routine clinical medicine.

### **Vasopressin Receptor**

vasopressin receptor is a protein or protein-related molecule that performs a defined structural, signaling, transport, immune, or enzymatic function in cells; abnormal amounts or activity may contribute to disease.

### **Vatalanib**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called vatalanib. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **VeIP Regimen**

A combination chemotherapy regimen of vinblastine, ifosfamide, and cisplatin, used in selected germ-cell tumors and other oncology settings. Treatment requires specialist monitoring for marrow, kidney, nerve, and bladder toxicity.

### **Velafermin**

A recombinant fibroblast-growth-factor analog studied to promote epithelial repair, including in ocular-surface and mucosal disease. It remains investigational in many settings.

### **Veliparib**

An investigational inhibitor of poly(ADP-ribose) polymerase studied in combination cancer treatment, particularly for tumors with impaired DNA

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repair. Its role depends on clinical-trial evidence and regulatory approval.

### **Veltuzumab**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called veltuzumab. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Vemurafenib**

Vemurafenib is a BRAF V600 kinase inhibitor used for selected BRAF-mutated melanoma and other cancers; arthralgia, photosensitivity, QT prolongation, new skin tumors, and resistance are important concerns.

### **Ventral Hernia**

Protrusion of abdominal tissue through a weakness in the front abdominal wall, including incisional and umbilical hernias. It may cause a bulge or pain and requires urgent assessment if incarceration or strangulation is suspected.

### **Vero Cell**

vero cell refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal location and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

### **Vesiculobullous Dermatoses**

A group of skin disorders characterized by vesicles or bullae caused by autoimmune, genetic, infectious, inflammatory, drug-related, or traumatic processes. Diagnosis depends on lesion morphology, distribution, biopsy, and immunofluorescence when indicated.

### **Vesiculovirus**

vesiculovirus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Vibration Problem**

A physiological or clinical process involving vibra-

tion problem. Its features, causes, and clinical significance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Vildagliptin**

An oral dipeptidyl-peptidase-4 inhibitor used in some countries for type 2 diabetes, alone or with other medicines. It improves glucose-dependent insulin secretion; liver function and pancreatitis symptoms may require attention.

### **Viomycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called viomycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Viral Antibody**

An immunoglobulin produced after infection or vaccination that recognizes a viral antigen; viral-antibody tests help assess previous exposure, immune response, or selected active infections, depending on the assay and timing.

### **Viral Carcinogenesis**

Viral carcinogenesis is cancer development driven or promoted by viral infection through oncogenic proteins, altered cell signaling, immune suppression, or chronic inflammation; examples include HPV, EBV, HBV, HCV, and HTLV-1.

### **Virginiamycin**

A medicine or pharmacologic agent called virginiamycin. Its uses, contraindications, interactions, and adverse effects depend on the specific agent and patient.

### **Viridans Streptococci**

viridans streptococci is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Virus Activation**

virus activation is a virus or viral group classified

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by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Assembly**

virus assembly is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Diseases**

virus diseases is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Integration**

virus integration is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Protein**

virus protein is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Receptor**

virus receptor is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Replication**

virus replication is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Virus Uncoating**

virus uncoating is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical impor-

tance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Vision Test**

An examination that measures visual acuity, fields, color, alignment, or eye structures to detect refractive error, retinal disease, optic-nerve dysfunction, glaucoma, or other causes of visual impairment.

### **Vaginal Bleeding**

Bleeding from the vagina outside an expected menstrual period or after menopause; causes include hormonal changes, infection, pregnancy-related conditions, structural lesions, or cancer.

### **Vaginal Odor**

An unusual or unpleasant odor from vaginal discharge that may result from bacterial vaginosis, infection, retained material, hormonal changes, or other conditions.

### **Vomiting Blood**

The passage of blood or coffee-ground material in vomit, usually indicating upper gastrointestinal bleeding. It is a potentially serious symptom requiring prompt medical evaluation.

### **Vaginal Candidiasis**

Alternate index label; see *Yeast infection (vaginal)*.

### **Vaginal Prolapse, Posterior**

Alternate index label; see *Posterior vaginal prolapse (rectocele)*.

### **Variant CJD**

Alternate index label; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease*.

### **Varices, Esophageal**

Alternate index label; see *Esophageal varices*.

### **Vascular Claudication**

Alternate index label; see *Claudication*.

### **VCJD**

Alternate index label; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease*.



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## Velocardiofacial Syndrome

Alternate index label; see *DiGeorge syndrome (22q11.2 deletion syndrome)*.

## Venereal Warts

Alternate index label; see *Genital warts*.

## Ventricular Premature Contraction

Alternate index label; see *Premature ventricular contractions (PVCs)*.

## Vertebral Hemangioma

Alternate index label; see *Spinal hemangioma*.

## V-Fib

Alternate index label; see *Ventricular fibrillation*.

## Vocal Fold Paralysis

Alternate index label; see *Vocal cord paralysis*.

## Von Recklinghausen's Disease

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

## Von Recklinghausen's Neurofibromatosis

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

## Von Recklinghausen's Phakomatosis

Alternate index label; see *Neurofibromatosis type 1*.

## VPCs

Alternate index label; see *Premature ventricular contractions (PVCs)*.

## Vaccines - Immunizations

Vaccines train the immune system to recognize specific pathogens or toxins and reduce the risk of infection, severe disease, complications, and transmission.

## Vaginal Bleeding Between Periods

Bleeding between menstrual periods may result from contraception, infection, pregnancy, polyps, fibroids, hormonal changes, or cancer and requires evaluation if persistent or heavy.

## Vaginal Bleeding In Early Pregnancy

Early-pregnancy bleeding can occur with implantation, cervical change, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, or other causes; severe pain, faintness, or heavy bleeding is urgent.

## Vaginal Bleeding In Late Pregnancy

Late-pregnancy bleeding may reflect placenta previa, placental abruption, labor, cervical disease, or another emergency and requires immediate obstetric assessment.

## Vaginal Bleeding In Pregnancy

Vaginal bleeding during pregnancy has causes ranging from benign cervical changes to miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, placenta problems, or labor and should be assessed clinically.

## Vaginal Cysts

Vaginal cysts are fluid-filled or tissue-lined sacs in or beside the vaginal wall, commonly benign but sometimes causing pain, pressure, infection, or obstruction.

## Vaginal Yeast Infection

A vaginal yeast infection is usually *Candida* overgrowth causing itching, burning, soreness, and thick discharge without the odor typical of many bacterial infections.

## Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococci - Hospital

Vancomycin-resistant enterococci are enterococcal bacteria resistant to vancomycin and capable of causing healthcare-associated urinary, bloodstream, wound, or other infections.

## Vasoactive Intestinal Peptide Test

Vasoactive intestinal peptide test examines vasoactive intestinal peptide test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

## VDRL Test

VDRL test examines vdr test; interpretation de-

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depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Venogram**

Venogram examines venogram; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Venogram - Leg**

Venogram - leg examines venogram - leg; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Vertebrobasilar Circulatory Disorders**

A clinical finding or condition involving vertebrobasilar Circulatory Disorders; evaluation depends on its characteristic features, causes, severity, and complications.

### **Vertigo-Associated Disorders**

Vertigo-associated disorders cause an illusion of movement from vestibular, neurologic, visual, medication-related, or systemic dysfunction and may be accompanied by imbalance, nausea, or hearing symptoms.

### **Vesicles**

Small, elevated, fluid-filled blisters on the skin or mucous membrane, generally less than 1 cm in diameter. Causes include viral infection, dermatitis, burns, and autoimmune blistering disease.

### **Viral Arthritis**

Viral arthritis is joint inflammation caused by or associated with a viral infection and may be acute, symmetric, and self-limited or part of a broader illness.

### **Viral Gastroenteritis (Stomach Flu)**

Viral gastroenteritis is infection of the stomach and intestines causing vomiting, watery diarrhea, cramps, and fever, with dehydration as the main acute risk.

**Synonyms:**  
Stomach Flu

### **Virilization**

Virilization is development of typically male secondary sexual features, such as hirsutism, deep voice, acne, increased muscle mass, or clitoromegaly, from androgen excess or androgen exposure.

### **Virtual Colonoscopy**

Virtual colonoscopy is CT colonography, which uses bowel preparation and gas or carbon-dioxide insufflation to create images of the colon; it can detect polyps and masses but cannot remove lesions or biopsy them.

### **Visceral Larva Migrans**

A syndrome caused by migration of animal nematode larvae through human tissues, most often from *Toxocara* species. It may produce fever, eosinophilia, liver lesions, or ocular and neurologic disease.

### **Visceromegaly**

Abnormal enlargement of one or more internal organs, such as the liver, spleen, or kidneys. It is a physical finding with causes that include infection, congestion, storage disease, inflammation, and cancer.

### **Vision - Night Blindness**

Difficulty seeing in dim light or adapting from bright to dark conditions, also called nyctalopia; causes include vitamin-A deficiency, retinal disease, cataract, and some inherited disorders.

### **Visual Acuity Test**

Visual acuity test examines visual acuity test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Vitamin A Blood Test**

Vitamin A blood test examines vitamin a blood test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Vitamin B12 Deficiency Anemia**

Vitamin B12 deficiency anemia is megaloblastic ane-

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mia from inadequate B12, impaired absorption, or medication effects and may cause irreversible neurologic injury if prolonged.

### **Vitamin B12 Level**

A biological substance or process involving vitamin B12 Level; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Vitamin C**

A biological substance or process involving vitamin C; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Vitamin K Deficiency Bleeding Of The Newborn**

A biological substance or process involving vitamin K Deficiency Bleeding Of The Newborn; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **VLDL Test**

VLDL test examines vldl test; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **Volvulus - Childhood**

Twisting of a loop of intestine around its mesentery, causing obstruction and potentially loss of blood supply. In children it is often related to intestinal malrotation and is a surgical emergency when acute.

### **Von Gierke Disease**

A clinical condition involving von Gierke Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Vascular Disease**

Vascular disease affects arteries, veins, or lymphatic vessels and includes atherosclerosis, aneurysm, peripheral artery disease, venous thrombosis, varicose disease, and inflammatory disorders. Symptoms and treatment depend on the vessel and may involve risk-factor control, medicines, procedures, or surgery.

### **Vertigo Overview**

Vertigo is the false sensation of movement, often caused by inner-ear disorders such as benign positional vertigo, vestibular neuritis, or Ménière disease, but sometimes by migraine or brain disease. New neurologic deficits, severe headache, or inability to walk is urgent.

### **VOR Reflex**

The vestibulo-ocular reflex stabilizes gaze by moving the eyes opposite to head movement through inner-ear, brainstem, and eye-muscle pathways. Damage can cause oscillopsia, vertigo, imbalance, and abnormal head-impulse testing.

### **Vaccines**

Biological preparations that stimulate active adaptive immunity against specific infectious agents or their toxins. They reduce the risk of infection, severe disease, complications, and transmission.

### **Vaginal Discharge**

Fluid released from the vagina that may be normal cervical or vaginal secretion or may reflect candidiasis, bacterial vaginosis, trichomoniasis, cervicitis, a retained foreign body, or another condition; odor, color, itching, pain, and bleeding guide evaluation.

### **Vaginal Fornix**

One of the recesses surrounding the cervix where the vagina meets the cervix. The posterior fornix is adjacent to the peritoneal cul-de-sac and is relevant in pelvic examination and some procedures.

### **Vaginal Hysterectomy**

Surgical removal of the uterus through the vagina. It may be used for selected benign uterine conditions and usually avoids an abdominal incision, although suitability depends on anatomy and disease.

### **Vaginal Introitus**

The entrance to the vaginal canal, located in the vestibule of the vulva. Its appearance and tenderness may be relevant in examinations for infection, trauma, pain, or pelvic-floor disorders.

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## Vaginal Membrane

A thin mucosal or connective-tissue fold associated with the vaginal canal; the term may refer to the hymen at the vaginal opening or to an abnormal obstructing membrane, so the intended anatomical meaning should be specified.

## Vaginal Opening

The external entrance to the vagina. It is part of the vulvar vestibule and may be affected by infection, inflammation, trauma, scarring, or congenital variation.

## Vaginal Vestibule

The area of the vulva enclosed by the labia minora that contains the openings of the urethra and vagina and the ducts of several glands.

## Vagus Nerve

The tenth cranial nerve, carrying parasympathetic, sensory, and motor fibres between the brainstem and the heart, lungs, gastrointestinal tract, pharynx, and larynx.

## Valsalva

Forced expiration against a closed glottis, which raises intrathoracic pressure. The maneuver affects venous return and heart rate and is used in selected examinations and treatments, but may be unsafe in some conditions.

## Valsalva Maneuver

Alternate index label; see *Valsalva's Manoeuvre* and *Valsalva*.

## Vampire Children

A nonmedical or colloquial expression, not a recognized diagnosis. A child with pallor, photosensitivity, anemia, or unusual dietary behavior requires assessment for an underlying medical condition rather than this label.

## Varicella (Chickenpox)

Varicella (chickenpox) refers to a defined body structure, tissue, or physiologic process; its normal loca-

tion and function provide the basis for interpreting related disease or injury.

## Vascular Bed

The network of blood vessels supplying a tissue or organ. Regional vascular beds regulate perfusion through vessel diameter, pressure, resistance, and local metabolic demands.

## Vasectomy

A permanent contraceptive procedure in which the vas deferens are divided or occluded to prevent sperm from entering the ejaculate. It does not immediately provide sterility and does not protect against sexually transmitted infections.

## Vasoconstriction

A physiological or clinical process involving vasoconstriction. Its features, causes, and clinical significance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## Vasodepressor Syncope

Fainting caused predominantly by a sudden reduction in vascular tone and blood pressure, often as part of a vasovagal reflex. Warning symptoms may include nausea, sweating, warmth, and lightheadedness.

## Vasodilators

Medicines or substances that relax vascular smooth muscle and widen blood vessels. They are used for conditions such as hypertension, angina, heart failure, or pulmonary hypertension depending on the agent.

## Vasovagal Reaction

A physiological or clinical process involving vasovagal reaction. Its features, causes, and clinical significance depend on the relevant body system and context.

## Veisalgia

The medical term for a hangover: the cluster of headache, thirst, nausea, fatigue, poor concentra-

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tion, and malaise that can follow alcohol use as blood alcohol falls.

### **Venereal**

Relating to sexual intercourse or to infection transmitted through sexual contact. The term is largely historical; sexually transmitted infection is the preferred modern expression.

### **Venereal Disease**

A clinical condition involving venereal Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

### **Venereal Disease Research Laboratory Test**

Venereal Disease Research Laboratory test is a medical test, procedure, treatment, or clinical measure used in patient care; its purpose and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

### **Venin**

A toxic secretion injected by an animal through a bite, sting, or other specialized apparatus. Its effects depend on the species, dose, route, and toxins involved.

### **Venipuncture**

Puncture of a vein with a needle to obtain blood, administer fluids or medicines, or establish intravenous access. Bruising, infection, bleeding, and nerve or artery injury are uncommon complications.

### **Venomous**

Describing an animal that actively delivers toxins through a bite, sting, spine, or similar mechanism. This differs from poisonous, which generally refers to toxicity after ingestion or contact.

### **Venous Aneurysm**

A localized abnormal dilatation of a vein. It may be asymptomatic or present as a soft mass, pain, thrombosis, embolism, or bleeding depending on its location and size.

### **Ventricular**

Relating to a ventricle, especially one of the heart or the brain. The meaning depends on the organ, such as ventricular tachycardia or a cerebral ventricular system.

### **Ventricular Arrhythmias**

Abnormal heart rhythms arising from the ventricles. They range from premature ventricular contractions to ventricular tachycardia and fibrillation, which can cause sudden cardiac arrest.

### **Verruca**

A benign epidermal growth caused by infection with a human papillomavirus. Common warts, plantar warts, and flat warts are clinical types; treatment depends on site, symptoms, and immune status.

### **Version**

A term describing a change in the position or presentation of a body structure, especially the fetus during pregnancy; its meaning depends on the clinical context.

### **Vertebrae**

Vertebrae are the bones of the spinal column that protect the spinal cord, support the body, allow movement, and provide attachment for muscles and ligaments.

### **Vertical**

Oriented from superior to inferior or perpendicular to a horizontal plane. In medicine, it may describe position, transmission from parent to child, or a body-oriented imaging or movement axis.

### **Vertical Transmission**

A physiological or clinical process involving vertical transmission. Its features, causes, and clinical significance depend on the relevant body system and context.

### **Vesicant**

A substance that causes blistering and tissue injury on contact. In oncology, vesicant drugs can cause

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severe extravasation injury if they escape from a vein into surrounding tissue.

### **Vesicular**

Characterized by or containing vesicles. The term commonly describes a vesicular rash or a vesicle-related structure in cell biology and pathology.

### **Vessel**

A vessel is a tube carrying blood, lymph, air, urine, bile, or another fluid through the body, depending on context.

### **Vestibular**

Relating to the vestibular system of the inner ear and brain, which detects head motion and position and helps maintain balance and gaze stability.

### **Vestibule, Vaginal**

The space of the vulva between the labia minora that contains the external openings of the urethra and vagina and the ducts of the greater and lesser vestibular glands.

### **Viable**

Capable of surviving or developing under suitable conditions. In clinical contexts it may describe a viable pregnancy, tissue, organism, cell, or treatment option.

### **Vincent Angina**

An acute necrotizing infection of the gums and oropharynx associated with fusobacteria and spirochetes. It causes painful ulceration, bleeding, foul breath, and gingival necrosis and requires dental or medical treatment.

### **Vincent Infection**

Vincent infection is acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis caused by mixed oral bacteria, producing painful bleeding gums, ulcers, and foul breath.

### **Vincent Stomatitis**

A painful necrotizing infection of the gums caused by mixed anaerobic bacteria, producing foul breath,

bleeding, ulceration, and gray necrotic tissue; it is also called acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis.

### **Viral Infection**

A viral infection occurs when a virus enters and replicates in host cells, causing symptoms that vary with the virus, tissue, immune response, and host.

### **Virginal Membrane**

A historical term usually referring to the hymen, a variable rim or fold of mucosal tissue at the vaginal opening; its appearance cannot reliably establish sexual history.

### **Virilize**

To virilize is to develop or cause typically male physical changes from androgen excess or treatment, including facial hair, voice deepening, acne, muscle change, or genital enlargement.

### **Viruses**

Viruses are infectious particles containing DNA or RNA within a protein coat, sometimes with a lipid envelope; they replicate only inside host cells and cause disease through direct injury or immune responses.

### **Visceral**

Relating to the internal organs, especially those within the thorax or abdomen, rather than the body wall or limbs.

### **Viscus**

An internal organ, particularly an organ in the thoracic or abdominal cavity; the plural is viscera.

### **Visual Field**

The entire area that can be seen while the eyes remain fixed in one position. Visual-field loss may result from retinal, optic-nerve, or brain lesions and is assessed by perimetry.

### **Vital**

Essential for life or relating to vital physiologic functions. Vital signs commonly include temperature,



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pulse, respiratory rate, blood pressure, and oxygen saturation.

### **Vitamin A**

A biological substance or process involving vitamin A; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Vitamin B1**

A vitamin or nutritional compound called vitamin b1. It supports specific physiological processes, and deficiency or excess can cause clinical disease.

### **Vitamin B12**

A vitamin or nutritional compound called vitamin b12. It supports specific physiological processes, and deficiency or excess can cause clinical disease.

### **Vitamin B2**

A vitamin or nutritional compound called vitamin b2. It supports specific physiological processes, and deficiency or excess can cause clinical disease.

### **Vitamin B6**

A vitamin or nutritional compound called vitamin b6. It supports specific physiological processes, and deficiency or excess can cause clinical disease.

### **Vitamin D3**

A vitamin or nutritional compound called vitamin d3. It supports specific physiological processes, and deficiency or excess can cause clinical disease.

### **Vitamin K**

A biological substance or process involving vitamin K; its medical significance depends on its function, location, amount, and clinical context.

### **Vitreous**

Relating to the transparent gel filling most of the space between the lens and retina, or describing a glass-like appearance. Vitreous disorders can cause floaters, hemorrhage, detachment, or retinal traction.

### **Voice Box**

The larynx, an organ in the neck containing the vocal folds and forming part of the airway. It produces voice and helps protect the lower respiratory tract during swallowing.

### **Void**

To empty the urinary bladder by urinating; in other medical contexts, void may mean an empty space or absence of a substance.

### **Volar**

Relating to the palm of the hand or sole of the foot, especially the surface opposite the dorsum.

### **Voluntary**

Under conscious control or performed by choice, such as voluntary movement. Voluntary action is distinguished from reflex, autonomic, or involuntary activity.

### **Vomit**

To eject stomach or upper gastrointestinal contents through the mouth; the expelled material may also be called vomitus. Persistent vomiting can cause dehydration and electrolyte abnormalities.

### **Vomitus**

Material expelled from the stomach or upper gastrointestinal tract during vomiting. Its color and contents can provide clues but do not by themselves establish a diagnosis.

### **Voyeurism**

A paraphilic disorder involving recurrent intense sexual arousal from observing an unsuspecting person who is naked, disrobing, or engaging in sexual activity, when it causes distress, impairment, or involves nonconsenting behavior.

### **Vulvar**

Relating to the vulva, the external female genital structures including the labia, clitoris, vestibule, and associated glands.

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### **Vulvitis, Yeast**

Inflammation of the vulva associated with vulvovaginal candidiasis, usually caused by *Candida* species. It may cause itching, burning, redness, swelling, and soreness and should be distinguished from other causes of vulvar symptoms.

### **Venae Cavae**

The superior and inferior venae cavae are the major veins returning systemic blood to the right atrium. The superior vena cava drains the head, neck, chest, and upper limbs; the inferior vena cava drains the abdomen, pelvis, and lower limbs.

#### **Synonyms:**

venae cava; vena cava

### **Vasa Deferentia**

The paired muscular ducts that transport mature sperm from the epididymides toward the ejaculatory ducts during ejaculation.

#### **Synonyms:**

vas deferens; ductus deferentes

### **Vulva**

The external female genital structures, including the mons pubis, labia, clitoris, and vestibule. It protects the openings of the urinary and reproductive tracts and contains specialized sensory and glandular tissue.

#### **Synonyms:**

female external genitalia

### **Vitreous Body**

The transparent gel filling the large space between the lens and retina. It helps maintain the shape of the eye and transmits light; age-related liquefaction can cause floaters or contribute to retinal traction.

#### **Synonyms:**

vitreous humor; vitreous

### **Vitamin Deficiency Anemia**

Anemia caused by inadequate vitamin B-12, folate, or other nutrients needed for normal red blood cell production.

### **Viral Hemorrhagic Fevers**

Severe viral infections that can cause fever, vascular injury, bleeding, shock, and organ failure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Bunyaviruses

### **Vaginal Bleeding After Sex**

Bleeding after vaginal intercourse; causes include cervical ectropion, infection, polyps, trauma, vaginal dryness, pregnancy-related conditions, or cancer. Persistent or recurrent bleeding needs evaluation.

### **Voice Disorders**

Conditions affecting voice quality, pitch, loudness, or ease of speaking because of problems involving the vocal folds, airway, nerves, or voice use.

#### **Synonyms:**

Difficulty Speaking

### **Vibrio Infection**

Infection caused by *Vibrio* bacteria, acquired through contaminated seafood or exposure of wounds to warm seawater. It may cause watery diarrhea, wound infection, or rapidly progressive sepsis, especially in people with liver disease or impaired immunity. Severe wound pain, blistering, fever, or shock requires emergency treatment.

#### **Synonyms:**

vibriosis.

### **Volume Overload**

Excess total body sodium and water, causing peripheral or pulmonary oedema; common causes include heart failure, kidney failure, liver disease, and excessive intravenous fluid, and treatment depends on the cause and severity.

### **Verrucous**

Having a rough, thickened, papillated, or wart-like surface.

### **Venous Thromboembolism**

Formation of a venous blood clot, usually deep-vein thrombosis, with or without embolization to the pulmonary arteries; pulmonary embolism is the

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major acute complication.

### **Viral Load**

The amount of virus or viral genetic material in a body fluid or tissue, measured by a laboratory assay; trends can help assess disease activity or response to antiviral treatment.

### **Variant Classification**

The process of assigning a genetic variant to categories such as benign, likely benign, uncertain significance, likely pathogenic, or pathogenic using evidence from population data, laboratories, family studies, functional studies, and clinical correlation.

### **Vulvar Intraepithelial Neoplasia**

A premalignant or potentially premalignant squamous lesion of the vulva. Most usual-type lesions are related to high-risk HPV, whereas differentiated lesions are commonly associated with lichen sclerosus and have a higher risk of invasive carcinoma.

### **Vulvar Squamous Cell Carcinoma**

The most common invasive vulvar malignancy, arising through HPV-related or HPV-independent pathways. It usually presents as a persistent mass, ulcer, plaque, or wart-like lesion and requires biopsy for diagnosis.

### **Viral Encephalitis**

Inflammation of the brain caused by a viral infection, resulting in dysfunction of neuronal tissue and surrounding inflammatory responses. Important causes include herpes simplex virus, varicella-zoster virus, enteroviruses, arboviruses, and other regionally prevalent pathogens. Clinical manifestations may include fever, headache, altered mental status, seizures, focal neurological deficits, or behavioral changes. Diagnosis requires urgent clinical assessment, cerebrospinal-fluid analysis, neuroimaging, and targeted microbiologic testing; treatment depends on the suspected virus and severity.

### **Vulvar Melanoma**

A malignant melanocytic neoplasm arising in vulvar skin or mucosa, most often affecting the labia

in older adults. It may present as a pigmented or amelanotic mass, plaque, ulcer, bleeding lesion, or persistent area of altered pigmentation. Diagnosis requires biopsy with assessment of tumor thickness, ulceration, mitotic activity, and regional or distant spread. Management is based on stage and resectability and may involve local excision, evaluation of regional lymph nodes, and systemic treatment for advanced disease.

### **Volkmann Contracture**

A permanent flexion deformity of the hand, wrist, and fingers caused by ischemic injury and fibrosis of forearm muscles. It most often follows untreated or inadequately treated compartment syndrome after fracture, crush injury, vascular compromise, or severe swelling. The degree of functional loss depends on the muscles and nerves affected and may include pain, weakness, sensory impairment, and restricted finger extension. Prevention requires urgent recognition of limb ischemia and compartment pressure; established contractures require reconstructive assessment and may need surgical release or tendon procedures.



## W

### Waardenburg Syndrome

A group of inherited disorders characterized by sensorineural hearing loss and pigmentary abnormalities of the eyes, hair, or skin. Dystopia canthorum, limb abnormalities, or intestinal aganglionosis may occur in particular genetic forms.

### Wait List

Registry of patients awaiting organ transplantation, maintained by national transplant organizations, prioritized by medical urgency and compatibility.

### Wall Stress

Force exerted on a heart chamber wall by pressure inside the chamber.

### Warfarin

An anticoagulant that reduces blood clot formation by inhibiting vitamin-K-dependent clotting factors.

### Wart

A benign skin growth caused by infection with human papillomavirus.

#### Synonyms:

Verruca

### Water Brash

A sudden increase in salty saliva associated with acid reflux.

### Wernicke's Area

A brain region important for understanding spoken and written language.

#### Synonyms:

Wernicke area

### White-Coat Hypertension

High blood pressure in a medical setting with normal readings outside it.

#### Synonyms:

White-coat effect

### Withdrawal

Physical or psychological symptoms that occur when a person who has developed dependence reduces or stops using a medicine or psychoactive substance. Symptoms vary by substance and may include anxiety, agitation, sweating, tremor, nausea, pain, insomnia, cravings, or seizures; some forms require urgent medical care.

#### Synonyms:

Withdrawal syndrome

### Womb

Common name for the uterus; the muscular organ where a fetus develops during pregnancy.

#### Synonyms:

Uterus

### Working Memory

The short-term holding and manipulation of information during a task.

### WAGR Syndrome

A contiguous-gene deletion syndrome involving Wilms tumor predisposition, aniridia, genitourinary anomalies, and variable developmental delay. It usually involves chromosome 11p13 and requires tumor surveillance and multidisciplinary care.

### Waist Circumference

A measure of abdominal adiposity taken at a stan-

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dardized site. Larger measurements are associated with increased cardiometabolic risk, but clinically used thresholds vary by sex, ancestry, and guideline; it complements, rather than replaces, body-mass index and other assessment.

### **Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia**

A rare B-cell lymphoplasmacytic lymphoma characterized by bone marrow infiltration by lymphoplasmacytic cells and production of monoclonal IgM paraprotein. It accounts for less than 2 percent of hematologic malignancies and typically affects older adults (median age 63-65 years).

#### **Synonyms:**

Lymphoplasmacytic Lymphoma

### **Waldenstrom's Macroglobulinemia**

A lymphoplasmacytic cancer of the bone marrow that produces excess IgM and may cause anemia, enlarged lymph nodes, or hyperviscosity symptoms.

### **Waldenström's Macroglobulinemia**

An indolent B-cell lymphoplasmacytic lymphoma characterized by the production of a monoclonal IgM paraprotein, causing hyperviscosity syndrome with visual disturbances, bleeding, and neurological symptoms. It typically affects elderly patients and involves the bone marrow, lymph nodes, spleen, and liver.

### **Wallerian Degeneration**

The breakdown of the portion of a nerve fiber separated from its cell body after nerve injury.

### **Walking Speed**

The rate at which a person walks, often measured over a defined distance. It can provide information about mobility and function, but no single speed determines disability in every person.

### **Wandering Spleen**

Abnormal mobility of the spleen caused by laxity or absence of its supporting ligaments. It may be asymptomatic or cause abdominal pain, splenic enlargement, torsion, infarction, or acute abdomen.

### **Warthin Tumor**

A benign salivary-gland neoplasm composed of oncocytic epithelial and lymphoid tissue, usually arising in the parotid gland. It is strongly associated with tobacco exposure, may be multifocal or bilateral, and is generally managed according to symptoms, diagnosis, and growth.

### **Warts**

Warts are benign epidermal growths caused by human papillomavirus, spreading by contact and varying in appearance by site and viral type.

### **Warty Dyskeratoma**

A benign follicular keratinizing tumor presenting as a solitary umbilicated papule or nodule, often on the head or neck. Histology shows a cup-shaped invagination filled with keratin and acantholytic dyskeratotic cells.

### **Watchful Waiting**

Planned observation without immediate active treatment, with clinical review and treatment if symptoms develop or the condition progresses. It may be used for selected cancers and other slowly progressive conditions.

### **Water Birth (Underwater Delivery)**

Delivery of a baby while the birthing person remains in a tub or pool of warm water. It may reduce perceived labor pain for some people, but evidence about delivery-related benefits and risks is limited. Eligibility, monitoring, and facility policies determine whether it is offered.

#### **Synonyms:**

Underwater Delivery

### **Water Intoxication**

A potentially life-threatening dilutional hyponatremia caused by excessive water intake or retention relative to the body's ability to excrete free water. Severe cases can cause headache, confusion, seizures, or coma.



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### Water Soluble Toxins

Toxic substances that dissolve readily in water. Their elimination depends on the substance, kidney function, metabolism, protein binding, and other properties; some may be removed by dialysis.

### Water-Borne Disease

Disease transmitted via contaminated water. Examples: cholera, typhoid, hepatitis A.

### Water-Deprivation Test

A supervised dynamic test assessing the kidney's ability to concentrate urine when free-water intake is withheld, followed when appropriate by desmopressin. It helps distinguish central diabetes insipidus, nephrogenic diabetes insipidus, and primary polydipsia but requires careful monitoring for hypernatremia and dehydration.

### Watery Eyes

Excessive tearing caused by irritation, allergy, infection, dry-eye reflex tearing, or blockage of the tear-drainage system. Persistent unilateral tearing or pain requires ocular assessment.

### Waxy Casts

Broad refractile cylindrical structures with smooth appearance indicating severe chronic kidney disease. Form from degeneration of granular casts in dilated tubules. Broad diameter reflects formation in dilated collecting ducts. Relatively specific for advanced CKD with significant tubular atrophy.

### Weakness, Generalized

Reduced strength affecting multiple body regions, caused by systemic illness, metabolic or electrolyte disturbance, medication, infection, muscle disease, nerve disease, neuromuscular-junction disease, or brain or spinal-cord disease. Sudden or progressive weakness, especially with speech, facial, breathing, or walking difficulty, requires urgent assessment.

### Weakness

Weakness is reduced force generation that may reflect muscle, nerve, neuromuscular-junction, brain, spinal cord, metabolic, systemic, or functional dis-

ease. limited to one body region. Causes include nerve or muscle disease, stroke, spinal disorders, metabolic abnormalities, infection, and deconditioning; sudden one-sided weakness is an emergency.

### Wear Debris

Particles generated by mechanical abrasion or degradation of implant materials. Macrophage-mediated inflammation around debris can produce osteolysis, implant loosening, and failure of an arthroplasty.

### Weaver Syndrome

A congenital overgrowth and neurodevelopmental disorder associated with pathogenic variants in *EZH2*. It may cause prenatal overgrowth, advanced bone age, characteristic facial features, hypotonia, developmental delay, and variable intellectual disability.

### Weber Test

The Weber test is a screening test for lateralization of hearing that uses a vibrating tuning fork (typically 512 Hz) placed on the midline of the skull (vertex or forehead) to determine whether the sound is heard equally in both ears or louder in one ear, providing information about the type and side of hearing loss.

### Wedge Resection

Surgical removal of a wedge-shaped piece of tissue, typically lung or breast. Used for diagnosis or treatment of localized lesions. Less extensive than lobectomy.

### Wegener's Granulomatosis

Wegener's granulomatosis, now called granulomatosis with polyangiitis, is a systemic vasculitis characterized by necrotizing granulomatous inflammation of the upper and lower respiratory tracts and pauci-immune necrotizing glomerulonephritis.

### Weight Gain In Pregnancy

Recommended gestational weight gain according to the Institute of Medicine (IOM) guidelines, based on prepregnancy BMI. Underweight (BMI <18.5): 28-40 lbs (12.5-18 kg). Normal weight (BMI 18.5-

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24.9): 25-35 lbs (11.5-16 kg). Overweight (BMI 25-29.9): 15-25 lbs (7-11.5 kg). Obese (BMI  $\geq$  30): 11-20 lbs (5-9 kg).

### Weight Loss

The intentional reduction of body weight, typically through a combination of dietary modification, increased physical activity, and behavioral changes. Achieving sustainable weight loss requires creating a consistent calorie deficit while preserving lean muscle mass through adequate protein intake and strength training.

#### Synonyms:

Obesity (Weight Loss)

### Weight Loss And Management

Weight loss and management encompasses the ongoing process of achieving and maintaining a healthy body weight through sustainable lifestyle modifications.

### Weight Loss Medications

Pharmacologic agents approved for the treatment of obesity when used in conjunction with lifestyle modifications.

### Weil's Disease

A zoonotic bacterial infection caused by spirochaetes of the genus *Leptospira*, transmitted through contact with water or soil contaminated with the urine of infected animals (rodents, cattle, dogs). See *Leptospirosis*.

### Wen (Epidermoid Cyst)

A common benign cyst beneath the skin that is lined by squamous epithelium and contains keratin debris.

#### Synonyms:

Epidermoid Cyst

### Werner Syndrome

An autosomal-recessive progeroid disorder caused most often by pathogenic variants in the *WRN* gene. It typically presents after puberty with premature ageing, short stature, bilateral cataracts,

scleroderma-like skin changes, thin limbs, diabetes, osteoporosis, vascular disease, and increased risk of malignancy.

### Wernicke's Encephalopathy

An acute neurologic disorder caused by thiamine deficiency, classically involving confusion, eye-movement abnormalities, and gait or coordination impairment. It requires prompt thiamine treatment.

### Wernicke-Korsakoff Syndrome

A neurologic disorder caused by thiamine deficiency, combining acute or previous Wernicke encephalopathy with persistent memory impairment and confabulation in some patients. Causes include alcohol-use disorder, malnutrition, and prolonged vomiting.

### West Nile Encephalitis

Inflammation of the brain caused by neuroinvasive West Nile virus, transmitted mainly by mosquitoes. It may cause fever, headache, confusion, tremor, weakness, seizures, or coma. There is no specific routine antiviral treatment; severe illness requires hospital-based supportive care.

### West Nile Virus

A mosquito-borne flavivirus that can cause asymptomatic infection, a febrile illness, or neuroinvasive disease such as meningitis, encephalitis, or acute flaccid paralysis. Risk of severe disease is higher in older adults and people with certain medical conditions.

### West Syndrome

An infantile epileptic encephalopathy characterized by epileptic spasms, hypsarrhythmia on electroencephalography, and developmental regression or arrest. Causes include structural brain disease, genetic disorders, metabolic disease, or acquired brain injury.

### Westermark Sign

A focal area of decreased pulmonary vascularity distal to an occluded pulmonary artery segment on a chest radiograph. It may occur with pulmonary embolism but is neither sensitive nor specific.

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### Wharton Jelly

A gelatinous substance (mucopolysaccharide matrix) surrounding the umbilical cord vessels, composed primarily of hyaluronic acid and chondroitin sulfate. It protects the umbilical vessels from compression and kinking during fetal movement and uterine contractions.

### Wheal

Raised, itchy swelling of skin (urticaria/hives). Caused by mast cell degranulation and histamine release. Examples: insect bite, allergic reaction, dermatographism.

### Wheezing

Wheezing is a musical sound from narrowed lower airways, commonly caused by asthma, infection, chronic lung disease, allergy, or an inhaled foreign body. airflow through narrowed or compressed lower airways during expiration (and occasionally inspiration). Pathophysiology: bronchospasm, mucosal edema, airway inflammation, or intraluminal secretions.

### Whiplash Injury

An acceleration-deceleration injury to the cervical spine, most commonly resulting from rear-end motor vehicle collisions. Mechanism: sudden hyperextension followed by hyperflexion of the neck causes stretching or tearing of cervical muscles, ligaments, facet joint capsules, and annulus fibrosus of intervertebral discs.

### Whipple Disease

A rare systemic bacterial infection caused by *Tropheryma whipplei*, affecting the small intestine and multiple organ systems. Presents with arthralgias (prodromal, years before GI symptoms), weight loss, chronic diarrhea, steatorrhea, and abdominal pain.

### Whipple Procedure

Pancreaticoduodenectomy for cancers of the pancreatic head, distal bile duct, or ampulla. Involves removal of the pancreatic head, duodenum, distal bile duct, and gallbladder with three anastomoses: hepaticojejunostomy, pancreaticojejunostomy, and

gastrojejunostomy. The pylorus-preserving variant maintains the entire stomach.

### Whipple Triad

A clinical framework supporting the diagnosis of symptomatic hypoglycemia: symptoms consistent with hypoglycemia, a documented low blood-glucose concentration, and improvement after the glucose level is raised. It is used when evaluating possible hypoglycemia, including suspected insulinoma.

### Whipworm (Trichuriasis)

Intestinal infection caused by the soil-transmitted helminth *Trichuris trichiura* (whipworm), endemic in tropical and subtropical regions with poor sanitation. Humans acquire infection by ingesting embryonated eggs from contaminated soil, food, or water.

#### Synonyms:

Trichuriasis

### Whispered Pectoriloquy

The ability to hear whispered words clearly through the stethoscope over consolidated lung tissue. It is a sign of pulmonary consolidation. Normally, whispered words are barely audible over the lung fields. It is one of the classic signs of pneumonia on physical examination.

### White Blood Cell Count

WBC count: the total number of leukocytes per unit volume (normal  $4.0\text{--}11.0 \times 10^9/\text{L}$ ), part of the CBC with differential (neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, basophils). Leukocytosis: infection (neutrophilia), inflammation, stress, steroids, leukemia (marked), corticosteroids.

### White Blood Cell Labeling

Nuclear medicine technique labeling WBCs with Tc-99m. Used for infection localization.

### White Cell

The cells of the immune system that defend the body against infection and foreign substances. Produced in the bone marrow from hematopoietic stem cells.

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### White Cell Count

A laboratory measurement of the number of white blood cells (leukocytes) in a given volume of blood, part of the complete blood count (CBC). Normal range: 4,000-11,000 cells/ $\mu$ L ( $4-11 \times 10^9$ /L). Differential white cell count measures the proportion of each leukocyte type: neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, basophils.

### White Infarction

White infarction, also known as anemic infarction, occurs in solid organs with end-arterial circulation where collateral blood supply is limited, resulting in pale, well-demarcated areas of coagulative necrosis.

#### Synonyms:

anemic infarction, occurs in solid organs with.

### White Matter

Regions of the brain and spinal cord composed primarily of myelinated nerve fibers, responsible for transmitting signals between brain regions.

### Whites (Leucorrhoea)

A non-bloody, physiological or pathological vaginal discharge. Physiological leucorrhoea: normal, clear to whitish, odourless discharge that varies with the menstrual cycle (increased at ovulation, pre-menstrually, during pregnancy, sexual arousal, and with oral contraceptive use).

#### Synonyms:

Leucorrhoea

### Whole Exome Sequencing

Sequencing the protein-coding regions of the genome, which make up a small fraction of total DNA. It can identify variants associated with disease but does not detect all genetic causes; its yield depends on the disorder, test quality, and interpretation.

### Whole Genome Sequencing

Determining complete DNA sequence of an individual's genome. Cost decreasing, clinical applications expanding. Identifies coding and non-coding variants.

### Whole-Body Scan

Acquisition of images covering entire body. Used for oncology staging, infection localization. PET/CT typically neck-to-mid-thigh or full body.

### Whole-Brain Radiation Therapy

Radiation directed at the entire brain, used for multiple brain metastases, leptomeningeal disease, and prophylactic cranial irradiation in small cell lung cancer and acute lymphoblastic leukemia.

### Whole-Genome Sequencing

Sequencing of nearly the complete nuclear genome, including coding and noncoding regions, together with mitochondrial DNA when covered by the assay. It can detect a broad range of variants but generates substantial interpretation and incidental-finding challenges.

### Whooping Cough

A highly contagious bacterial infection caused by *Bordetella pertussis*, producing characteristic paroxysmal cough with whooping inspiratory sound. See Pertussis.

### Williams Syndrome

A microdeletion syndrome involving the elastin gene on chromosome 7q11.23. Features: elfin facies, supralvalvular aortic stenosis, hypercalcemia, intellectual disability with strong verbal skills, and overly friendly personality. Often associated with connective tissue abnormalities.

### Wilms Tumor

A malignant embryonal tumor of the kidney in children. It may present as an abdominal mass, pain, hematuria, or an incidental finding and may be associated with syndromes such as WAGR or Beckwith-Wiedemann syndrome. Treatment and prognosis depend on stage and tumor biology.

#### Synonyms:

Cancer, Wilms' Tumor

### Wilms' Tumor (Nephroblastoma)

An embryonal malignant tumor of the kidney that

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usually occurs in young children. It may be associated with congenital syndromes, and treatment and prognosis depend on tumor stage, histology, and molecular features.

**Synonyms:**

Nephroblastoma

**Wilson Disease**

Autosomal recessive copper metabolism disorder (ATP7B gene). Copper accumulation in liver, brain, cornea. Kayser-Fleischer rings, hepatopathy, movement disorder, psychiatric symptoms. Treatment: chelation (penicillamine, trientine), zinc, liver transplant.

**Wilson's Disease**

An autosomal recessive disorder of copper metabolism caused by mutations in the ATP7B gene, leading to impaired biliary copper excretion and toxic copper accumulation in the liver, brain, cornea, and other organs.

**Windowing**

Adjusting CT image brightness and contrast to optimize visualization of specific tissues. Bone window: wide window width, high level. Soft tissue window: narrow width, mid level. Lung window: wide width, low level.

**Windpipe**

The windpipe, a 10-12 cm fibrocartilaginous tube from the larynx (C6) to the carina (T4/T5) where it bifurcates into main bronchi. See Trachea.

**Wireless Motility Capsule**

Ingestible capsule that measures pH, pressure, and temperature throughout the gastrointestinal tract. Provides regional transit times through the stomach, small bowel, and colon in a single test. The pH sensor identifies transition points between segments based on characteristic pH changes.

**Wiskott-Aldrich Syndrome**

X-linked recessive disorder (WAS gene mutation, encodes WASP protein, regulates actin polymerization in hematopoietic cells). Triad: microthrom-

bocytopenia (small platelets, <70 fl), eczema, recurrent infections (encapsulated bacteria, viruses). Combined immunodeficiency with progressive T-cell lymphopenia.

**Withdrawal Reflex**

A protective polysynaptic spinal reflex in which a painful stimulus causes flexion (withdrawal) of the stimulated limb, removing it from the source of injury, with reciprocal extension of the contralateral limb (crossed extensor reflex) to maintain posture.

**Withdrawal Symptoms**

Physical or psychological symptoms that occur when a person stops or reduces a substance or medicine after the body has adapted to it. The symptoms depend on the substance, duration of use, and the person's health.

**Withdrawal Syndrome**

A predictable set of signs and symptoms that occur when a drug is discontinued or the dose is reduced after chronic use, reflecting the physiological rebound from drug adaptation.

**Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome**

A pre-excitation syndrome caused by an accessory pathway (bundle of Kent) connecting atria and ventricles, bypassing the AV node. ECG shows short PR interval (<0.12 s), delta wave (slurred upstroke of QRS), and widened QRS.

**Synonyms:**

Wolff Parkinson White Syndrome (Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome)

**Wolfram Syndrome**

Autosomal recessive disorder caused by mutations in the WFS1 gene encoding wolframin. Classic triad of diabetes mellitus, optic atrophy, and diabetes insipidus. Additional features include sensorineural deafness, neurodegeneration, and psychiatric illness. Onset of diabetes typically in the first decade.

**Wolman's Disease**

A severe lysosomal acid-lipase deficiency presenting in infancy with hepatosplenomegaly, adrenal cal-



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cification, malabsorption, vomiting, diarrhea, and failure to thrive. It is a severe form of lysosomal acid-lipase deficiency and can be fatal early without treatment.

### **Wood Lamp Examination**

Inspection of skin under long-wave ultraviolet A light in a darkened room. It can accentuate pigimentary differences and produce characteristic fluorescence in selected infections, but findings are not independently diagnostic.

### **Woods Corkscrew Maneuver**

An internal rotation maneuver for shoulder dystocia where the operator inserts a hand and rotates the fetal shoulders 180 degrees by applying pressure to the posterior aspect of the anterior shoulder. This disimpacts the shoulder from behind the symphysis pubis. Can be repeated if the shoulder re-impacts in the new position.

### **Woods Screw Maneuver**

A rotational maneuver used during shoulder dystocia to rotate the fetal shoulders and assist delivery.

### **Word Recognition Scoring**

An audiologic test measuring how accurately a person repeats or identifies spoken words at a comfortable listening level.

### **Word Salad**

Severe disorganized speech consisting of a jumble of words and phrases that lack meaning or logical connection. It is a hallmark of formal thought disorder in schizophrenia and represents the most severe form of disorganized speech. It reflects profound disruption of language processing.

### **Wound**

An injury in which tissue is damaged by trauma, surgery, pressure, heat, chemicals, or other causes. Wounds may be open or closed and vary in depth, contamination, and effect on nearby structures.

### **Wound Care**

Management of traumatic wounds: irrigation, debridement, closure (sutures, staples, glue), dressing. Tetanus prophylaxis based on vaccination history and wound type. Antibiotics for contaminated wounds, animal/human bites, or signs of infection. Healing: primary, secondary, tertiary intention.

### **Wound Complication**

A problem that develops during healing, such as infection, separation of wound edges, bleeding, fluid collection, tissue death, or excessive scarring. Increasing pain, redness, swelling, drainage, fever, or wound opening should be assessed promptly.

### **Wound Dehiscence**

Separation of the layers of a surgical wound after closure, most commonly occurring within 3-14 days postoperatively.

### **Wound Healing**

Complex process of tissue repair. Phases: hemostasis, inflammation, proliferation, remodeling. Implant integration depends on healing.

### **Wound Healing Phases**

Wound healing involves overlapping stages of hemostasis, inflammation, tissue formation, epithelial coverage, and remodeling. The duration and result depend on the wound, blood supply, infection, nutrition, and overall health.

### **Wound Infection**

Infection of a wound by microorganisms, causing findings such as increasing pain, redness, warmth, swelling, pus, fever, or delayed healing.

### **Wound VAC**

Vacuum-assisted closure for wound healing. Foam dressing connected to vacuum pump. Removes exudate, reduces edema, promotes granulation. Used for complex wounds, surgical sites, pressure ulcers.

### **Wrisberg Ganglion**

A sensory ganglion associated with the intermediate



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nerve of the facial nerve.

### **Wrist Drop**

Inability to extend the wrist and fingers, usually caused by radial nerve dysfunction.

### **Wrist Joint**

Condylloid synovial joint between distal radius and articular disc proximally and scaphoid/lunate/triquetrum distally. Allows flexion, extension, radial/ulnar deviation, circumduction. The triangular fibrocartilage complex absorbs ulnar side load.

### **Wrist Pain**

Pain in or around the wrist, commonly caused by sprain, fracture, tendinitis, arthritis, or nerve compression such as carpal tunnel syndrome. Persistent pain, deformity, numbness, or weakness requires assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain, Wrist

### **Wuchereria**

A genus of filarial nematodes that includes *Wuchereria bancrofti*, a major cause of lymphatic filariasis. Infection is transmitted by mosquitoes and may cause lymphangitis, chronic lymphedema, hydrocele, and elephantiasis.

### **Wheat Allergy**

An immune reaction to proteins in wheat that may cause skin, digestive, or breathing symptoms.

### **Whiplash**

A neck injury caused by a rapid back-and-forth movement of the head.

#### **Synonyms:**

Pain Whiplash (Whiplash) Sprain Neck (Whiplash) Strain Neck (Whiplash)

### **Whipple's Disease**

A rare bacterial infection that can impair intestinal absorption and affect multiple organs.

#### **Synonyms:**

Intestinal Lipodystrophy Lipodystrophy, Intestinal

### **Wheeze**

A high-pitched whistling sound produced by narrowed airways during breathing.

### **Wright Stain**

A blood-cell stain used to identify and classify cells in a blood smear.

### **White Blood Cells**

Leukocytes, immune cells that circulate in blood and protect the body against infection, foreign substances, and abnormal cells.

### **Wolman Disease**

A rare autosomal-recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by lysosomal acid lipase deficiency, leading to accumulation of cholesteryl esters and triglycerides, adrenal calcification, hepatosplenomegaly, diarrhea, and severe early-onset disease.

### **Wernicke Encephalopathy**

An acute neurologic disorder caused by thiamine deficiency, classically producing confusion, impaired coordination, and abnormal eye movements. It is a medical emergency requiring prompt thiamine treatment.

### **Wrist Fracture**

A break in one or more bones near the wrist, most commonly the distal radius or ulna, usually caused by a fall, direct trauma, or weakened bone.

### **Wrist Sprain**

Stretching or tearing of one or more ligaments supporting the wrist, causing pain, swelling, bruising, and reduced movement after injury.

### **Wet Macular Degeneration**

The neovascular form of age-related macular degeneration in which abnormal blood vessels grow beneath or within the retina and leak fluid or blood, causing rapid central-vision loss.

#### **Synonyms:**

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Macular Degeneration, Wet Wet Age-Related Macular Degeneration Wet AMD

### **Wound Evisceration**

Separation of a surgical wound with protrusion of internal organs or tissue through the opening. It is a surgical emergency requiring protection of the exposed tissue and urgent medical evaluation.

### **Wassermann Reaction**

A historical complement-fixation blood test for syphilis. It has largely been replaced by modern treponemal and nontreponemal serologic tests.

### **Wasp Sting**

A venomous insect sting that may cause localized pain, redness, and swelling; severe reactions can include anaphylaxis or, rarely, systemic envenomation.

### **Water-Hammer Pulse (Corrigan Pulse)**

A pulse with a rapid upstroke and collapse, classically associated with significant aortic regurgitation and other states of increased pulse pressure.

#### **Synonyms:**

Corrigan Pulse

### **Weaning**

Gradual reduction and eventual discontinuation of breastfeeding, bottle-feeding, or a medicine or other treatment, according to the relevant clinical context.

### **Wenckebach Phenomenon (Mobitz Type I AV Block)**

Progressive prolongation of the PR interval followed by a nonconducted atrial impulse and a dropped QRS complex. It reflects intermittent impairment of atrioventricular conduction.

#### **Synonyms:**

Mobitz Type I AV Block

### **White Finger**

Episodic pallor or whitening of the fingers caused by vasospasm, commonly associated with Raynaud phenomenon or hand-arm vibration syndrome.

### **White Leg (Phlegmasia Alba Dolens)**

Painful, marked swelling and pallor of a limb caused by extensive deep venous thrombosis, usually involving major venous outflow. It requires urgent assessment.

#### **Synonyms:**

Phlegmasia Alba Dolens

### **Whitlow (Paronychia)**

Acute or chronic infection and inflammation of the tissues around a fingernail or toenail, usually caused by bacteria, fungi, or repeated moisture and trauma.

#### **Synonyms:**

Paronychia

### **Widal Reaction**

An agglutination test historically used to detect antibodies associated with *Salmonella Typhi* and paratyphoid infection. Its diagnostic accuracy is limited, and results require clinical interpretation.

### **Wisdom Tooth (Third Molar)**

The last molar in each dental quadrant, usually erupting in late adolescence or early adulthood. Impaction may cause pain, infection, or damage to adjacent teeth.

#### **Synonyms:**

Third Molar

### **Witch's Milk (Neonatal Galactorrhea)**

A temporary milk-like breast secretion in a newborn caused by exposure to maternal hormones. It usually resolves without treatment; the breasts should not be squeezed.

#### **Synonyms:**

Neonatal Galactorrhea

### **Wool-Sorter's Disease (Anthrax)**

An occupational form of inhalational anthrax caused by inhalation of spores of *Bacillus anthracis*, historically associated with handling contaminated wool or animal products.

#### **Synonyms:**

Anthrax

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### **Word Blindness (Alexia)**

An acquired neurological disorder in which a person loses or markedly impairs the ability to read despite adequate vision and previously acquired language skills.

#### **Synonyms:**

Alexia

### **Word Deafness (Auditory Verbal Agnosia)**

An acquired inability to understand spoken words despite adequate hearing, often caused by dysfunction of auditory-language pathways.

#### **Synonyms:**

Auditory Verbal Agnosia

### **Worm Infestation (Helminthiasis)**

Infection by parasitic worms, including nematodes, cestodes, and trematodes. Manifestations depend on the species and the organs involved.

#### **Synonyms:**

Helminthiasis

### **Writer's Cramp**

A task-specific focal dystonia causing involuntary muscle contractions and abnormal postures during writing or closely related fine-motor activities.

### **Wryneck (Torticollis)**

Abnormal tilting or rotation of the head caused by involuntary contraction, shortening, or dysfunction of neck muscles. It may be congenital, acquired, painful, or neurological.

### **Wafer**

Thin, flat disc used in pharmaceutical formulations for controlled drug delivery, particularly in intravitreal implants for retinal conditions.

### **Waist-Hip Ratio**

Anthropometric measure calculated by dividing waist circumference by hip circumference; used to assess central obesity and cardiovascular risk.

### **Wakefulness**

State of being conscious and alert; regulated by the reticular activating system and neurotransmitters including orexin, histamine, and acetylcholine.

### **Ward's Triangle**

Radiological landmark formed by the intersection of the iliopectineal line, ilioischial line, and teardrop line on pelvic radiographs; used to assess acetabular coverage.

### **Warfarin Syndrome**

A pattern of fetal abnormalities caused by warfarin exposure during pregnancy, including nasal and skeletal abnormalities, eye or neurologic defects, and fetal or neonatal bleeding.

### **Warm Ischemia**

Tissue oxygen deprivation at body temperature due to interrupted blood supply; occurs during organ procurement for transplantation and causes more cellular damage than cold ischemia.

### **Washout Period**

Interval between discontinuation of a drug or treatment and the start of a subsequent treatment phase; allows clearance of prior agents to avoid confounding effects in clinical studies.

### **Water**

Essential solvent for physiological processes; involved in hydration, thermoregulation, nutrient transport, and waste elimination. Deficiency leads to dehydration; excess causes water intoxication.

### **Water Channel**

Aquaporin membrane proteins that facilitate rapid transcellular water transport; found in renal collecting ducts, red blood cells, and other tissues involved in fluid homeostasis.

### **Water Consumption**

Fluid intake requirement for maintaining hydration; approximately 2-3 liters daily for adults, varying with climate, activity level, and individual physio-

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logical needs.

### **Water Pollution**

Contamination of water bodies with pathogens, chemicals, or heavy metals; associated with gastrointestinal illness, developmental disorders, and chronic disease.

### **Water Supply**

Infrastructure for delivering potable water to populations; public health measures include chlorination, filtration, and monitoring for contamination.

### **Water-Soluble Vitamin**

Vitamin class dissolving in water and not stored in significant amounts; includes B-complex vitamins and vitamin C, requiring regular dietary intake.

### **Webbed Neck**

Lateral cervical skin folds extending from the mastoid process to the acromion; characteristic of Turner syndrome and Noonan syndrome.

### **Weber**

Unit of measurement for the frequency of bone conduction; used in audiology testing (Weber test) to lateralize hearing loss.

### **Wedge Excision**

Surgical removal of a triangular or wedge-shaped portion of tissue; commonly performed for breast biopsies, cervical lesions, and skin tumors.

### **Weeksella**

Genus of Gram-negative bacteria in the family Neisseriaceae; occasionally isolated from clinical specimens.

### **Weeksella Virosa**

Species of Gram-negative, oxidase-positive bacteria; opportunistic pathogen rarely associated with human infection.

### **Weight Gain**

Increase in body weight; may be intentional (muscle

building, pregnancy) or unintentional (fluid retention, endocrine disorders, medication effects).

### **Werner's Syndrome**

An autosomal-recessive premature-aging disorder caused by WRN gene defects, characterized after childhood by short stature, cataracts, scleroderma-like skin, diabetes, atherosclerosis, and increased cancer risk.

### **Wernicke Area**

Region of the left dominant cerebral hemisphere (Brodmann area 22) involved in language comprehension; damage causes Wernicke aphasia with fluent but nonsensical speech.

### **Western Blotting**

Laboratory technique for detecting specific proteins in tissue samples using gel electrophoresis, membrane transfer, and antibody-based detection; used in HIV diagnosis and research.

### **Wheeled Stretcher**

Mobile patient transport device with wheels; used in hospitals and emergency services for moving patients who cannot walk.

### **Whirlpool Bath**

Hydrotherapy device providing agitated water for therapeutic bathing; used in wound care, physical therapy, and rehabilitation.

### **Whole-Body Irradiation**

Radiotherapy technique delivering radiation to the entire body; used as conditioning before bone marrow transplantation or for treatment of systemic hematologic malignancies.

### **Wickerhamiella Pararugosa**

Species of basidiommatous yeast; rarely isolated from clinical specimens, generally considered a contaminant.

### **Wolinella**

Genus of anaerobic, Gram-negative bacteria found

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in the oral cavity and gastrointestinal tract; associated with periodontal disease.

### **Wolinella Succinogenes**

wolinella succinogenes is a gene, genetic trait, chromosome-related concept, or inherited process that affects biological function through DNA variation or gene regulation.

### **Women's Health**

Medical specialty focusing on conditions unique to or more prevalent in females, including reproductive health, pregnancy, menopause, and gender-specific disease patterns.

#### **Synonyms:**

Womens Health (Women's Health)

### **Wortmannin**

Fungal metabolite and potent inhibitor of phosphatidylinositol 3-kinase (PI3K); used extensively in cell biology research.

### **Wrist**

Complex joint connecting the hand to the forearm; composed of eight carpal bones, ligaments, and tendons allowing flexion, extension, abduction, and adduction.

### **Wrist Injury**

Damage to the bones, ligaments, tendons, nerves, or vessels of the wrist from a fall, twist, impact, or overuse; fracture, instability, severe swelling, or neurovascular symptoms require assessment.

### **Written Documentation**

Formal recording of patient information, clinical decisions, and treatment plans; essential for continuity of care and medicolegal purposes.

#### **Synonyms:**

Torticollis

### **White Tongue**

A white coating or patches on the tongue caused by debris, dry mouth, irritation, infection, inflammation, or other oral conditions.

### **Warts, Common**

Alternate index label; see *Common warts*.

### **Warts, Genital**

Alternate index label; see *Genital warts*.

### **Warts, Plantar**

Alternate index label; see *Plantar warts*.

### **Warts, Venereal**

Alternate index label; see *Genital warts*.

### **Water On The Knee**

Alternate index label; see *Swollen knee*.

### **Wermer Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple endocrine neoplasia, type 1 (MEN 1)*.

### **Wermer's Syndrome**

Alternate index label; see *Multiple endocrine neoplasia, type 1 (MEN 1)*.

### **Wet Age-Related Macular Degeneration**

Alternate index label; see *Wet macular degeneration*.

### **Wet AMD**

Alternate index label; see *Wet macular degeneration*.

### **White Blood Cell Disorders In Children**

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric white blood cell disorders*.

### **Wax**

A water-resistant substance produced by ceruminous glands in the ear canal; earwax protects the canal and usually clears naturally.

### **Webbed Fingers**

Partial or complete joining of adjacent fingers by skin or soft tissue, known as syndactyly; it may be congenital or acquired.

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### Weever Fish

A venomous marine fish whose dorsal spines can cause a painful sting, local swelling, and occasionally systemic symptoms.

### Weight-Reducing Diets

Dietary plans intended to create a sustained energy deficit and reduce excess body weight, ideally individualized with attention to nutrition, health conditions, and long-term adherence.

### Wens

Common benign cysts beneath the skin, usually epidermoid cysts containing keratin; they may become inflamed or infected.

### Wertheim's Hysterectomy

Radical hysterectomy involving removal of the uterus, cervix, surrounding tissues, and commonly the upper vagina and pelvic lymph nodes, historically used for cervical cancer.

### Wet Dream

Involuntary ejaculation during sleep, usually occurring in adolescence or adulthood and generally a normal physiological event.

### Whiplash Injuries

Neck injuries caused by rapid acceleration and deceleration, producing strain of cervical muscles, ligaments, joints, or other soft tissues.

### White Blood Cell

A leukocyte made mainly in bone marrow and found in blood and lymphatic tissues that helps defend against infection and other abnormal or foreign material. Major types are neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils; abnormal numbers or function may indicate infection, inflammation, immune disease, or marrow disorders.

### White Of The Eye

The sclera, the tough, opaque outer coat of the eye surrounding the cornea and helping maintain the shape of the globe.

### Whitlow

An infection or inflammation of the tissues around a finger or toenail, often involving the nail fold; it may be bacterial, fungal, or herpetic.

### Whooping-Cough

A highly contagious respiratory infection caused by *Bordetella pertussis*, characterized by bouts of coughing that may be followed by a whooping inspiration.

### Widal Test

An agglutination test historically used to detect antibodies associated with typhoid and paratyphoid fever; its limited accuracy means results require clinical interpretation.

### Wilm's Tumour

Source spelling variant of *Wilms tumor*, a malignant embryonal kidney tumor occurring mainly in young children.

### Winter Vomiting Disease

An acute gastroenteritis, usually caused by norovirus, characterized by sudden vomiting, diarrhea, and abdominal cramps.

### Wolffian Ducts

Embryonic mesonephric ducts that form parts of the male reproductive tract, including the epididymal duct, vas deferens, and ejaculatory ducts; most regress in typical female development.

### Wood Naphtha

A historical term for methanol-containing wood distillate; ingestion or inhalation can cause severe metabolic acidosis, visual loss, and death.

### Wood's Light

Long-wave ultraviolet-A light used in a darkened room to enhance certain skin-color changes and aid assessment of selected dermatological conditions.

### Wood Spirit

An old name for methanol, a toxic alcohol whose



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ingestion can cause metabolic acidosis, blindness, and death.

### Woody Tongue

A rare chronic infection, usually caused by *Actinomyces*, producing a hard, swollen tongue and surrounding tissue inflammation.

### Wool-Sorters' Disease

An occupational form of inhalational anthrax caused by inhaling spores of *Bacillus anthracis* while handling contaminated wool or animal products.

### Word Blindness

An older term for alexia, an acquired inability to read or recognize written words despite adequate vision and previously developed language ability, usually caused by brain dysfunction or injury.

### Wounds

Injuries in which tissue is damaged by trauma, surgery, pressure, heat, chemicals, or other causes; wounds may be open or closed and may require cleansing, closure, or debridement.

### Wry-Neck

Torticollis, an abnormal tilt or rotation of the head caused by involuntary contraction, shortening, or dysfunction of neck muscles.

### Wuchereria Bancrofti

A filarial nematode transmitted by mosquitoes and the major cause of lymphatic filariasis, which can produce lymphoedema and elephantiasis.

### White Spot Disease

Alternate index label; see *Lichen sclerosus*.

### Whiteheads

Whiteheads are closed comedones formed when oil and dead skin block a hair follicle, producing small pale or skin-colored acne bumps.

### Wisdom Teeth, Impacted

Alternate index label; see *Impacted wisdom teeth*.

### Wolff-Parkinson-White Accessory Pathway-Related Tachycardia

Alternate index label; see *Wolff-Parkinson-White (WPW) syndrome*.

### Wrinkle

Alternate index label; see *Wrinkles*.

### Walking Abnormalities

Walking abnormalities include changes in speed, balance, stride, posture, or coordination caused by pain, weakness, sensory loss, joint disease, or neurologic illness.

### Wart Remover Poisoning

Wart remover poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to wart remover poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### Water In Diet

Water in diet addresses care related to water in diet, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### Waterhouse-Friderichsen Syndrome

Waterhouse-Friderichsen syndrome is adrenal hemorrhage and acute adrenal failure associated with overwhelming sepsis, classically meningococcal infection, causing shock and coagulopathy.

### Wax Poisoning

Wax poisoning involves toxic or environmental exposure to wax poisoning; dose, route, timing, symptoms, and organ involvement determine urgency and treatment.

### WBC Count

WBC count examines wbc count; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### Webbing Of The Fingers Or Toes

Partial or complete joining of adjacent fingers or toes by skin or other tissue. It is called syndactyly

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and may be congenital or acquired.

### **Weight Gain – Unintentional**

Weight gain – unintentional addresses care related to weight gain – unintentional, including practical measures, warning signs, follow-up, and decisions to discuss with a clinician.

### **Weight Loss - Unintentional**

Unintentional weight loss is reduction in body weight without planned dietary or activity change and may result from malignancy, endocrine disease, infection, gastrointestinal disease, medication, or mood disorder.

### **Weight-Loss Medicines**

Medications used, together with nutrition and physical-activity measures, to help reduce or maintain body weight in selected people with overweight or obesity. Choice depends on medical history, benefits, risks, and treatment goals.

### **West Nile Virus Infection**

West Nile virus infection is a mosquito-borne illness ranging from fever and body aches to neuroinvasive meningitis, encephalitis, weakness, or paralysis.

### **Whipworm Infection**

Whipworm infection examines whipworm infection; interpretation depends on the specimen or body region, test method, reference range, and clinical question.

### **White Matter Of The Brain**

The brain tissue composed mainly of myelinated axons and supporting glial cells, connecting different brain regions and the brain with the spinal cord; disease or injury can impair cognition, sensation, coordination, or movement.

### **Whole Breast Radiation Therapy**

Whole breast radiation therapy treats remaining breast tissue after breast-conserving surgery to reduce local recurrence risk, with planned dosing and monitoring for skin and tissue effects.

### **Widely Spaced Teeth**

Teeth separated by unusually large gaps, also called diastema when the gap is localized. Causes include normal development, missing teeth, tooth-size differences, habits, or jaw and gum conditions.

### **Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome (WPW)**

Wolff-Parkinson-White syndrome is pre-excitation through an extra atrioventricular pathway that can cause episodes of supraventricular tachycardia and rarely dangerous ventricular rhythms.

### **Wrinkles**

Wrinkles are skin folds or lines produced by aging, sun exposure, repeated facial movement, loss of elasticity, smoking, or other factors.

#### **Synonyms:**

Wrinkle

### **Wrist Arthroscopy**

Wrist arthroscopy uses a small camera and instruments through portals to diagnose or treat cartilage, ligament, synovial, or other wrist problems.

### **Wrist Sprain - Aftercare**

Recovery care after stretching or tearing of wrist ligaments, including protection, swelling control, gradual motion and strengthening, and reassessment if pain, instability, or numbness persists.

### **Warts (Common Warts)**

Alternate index label for Common Warts.

### **Warts (Warts (Common Warts))**

Alternate index label for Warts (Common Warts).

### **Warts Genital (Genital Warts In Women)**

Alternate index label for Genital Warts In Women.

### **Weber-Christian Disease**

Weber-Christian disease is an older, nonspecific term historically used for relapsing fever and inflammation of subcutaneous fat, now often classified as panniculitis. Painful subcutaneous nodules and sys-

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temic symptoms require modern evaluation for infection, autoimmune disease, pancreatic disease, or other causes.

**Synonyms:**

Panniculitis Idiopathic Nodular (Weber-Christian Disease)

**Wegeners Granulomatosis  
(Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis)**

Alternate index label for Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis.

**Weils Disease (Leptospirosis)**

Alternate index label for Leptospirosis.

**Wet Dry Drowning (Drowning)**

Alternate index label for Drowning.

**Wisdom Teeth**

Wisdom teeth are the third molars that commonly emerge in late adolescence or adulthood. Impaction, infection, decay, cysts, gum disease, or crowding can cause pain and swelling; dental examination and imaging determine whether monitoring or removal is appropriate.

**Wolff Parkinson White Syndrome  
(Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome)**

Alternate index label for Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome.

**Womb Growths (Uterine Fibroids)**

Alternate index label for Uterine Fibroids.

**Women Breast Lumps (Breast Lumps In Women)**

Alternate index label for Breast Lumps In Women.

**Women Disease Prevention (Disease Prevention In Women)**

Alternate index label for Disease Prevention in Women.

**Womens Health (Women's Health)**

Alternate index label for Women's Health.

**Worms Pinworms (Pinworm Infection)**

Alternate index label for Pinworm Infection.

**Wuhan Coronavirus (2019-NCoV)**

Alternate index label for 2019-nCoV.

**Walleye**

Walleye is an informal term for strabismus, in which the eyes are misaligned and do not point at the same target.

**Walleyed**

Walleyed describes eyes that appear misaligned or divergent; clinically, the condition may be strabismus and requires eye assessment when persistent.

**Wasting**

Abnormal loss of body weight, muscle, or other tissue, often associated with chronic disease, inadequate nutrition, inflammation, or cancer. Severe wasting may impair strength, immunity, and recovery.

**Water Blister**

A fluid-filled blister, usually containing clear serum, caused by friction, pressure, burns, or some skin disorders. The blister should be protected from further trauma and assessed if infected or widespread.

**Water On The Brain**

A nontechnical term usually referring to hydrocephalus, an abnormal accumulation or impaired circulation of cerebrospinal fluid that enlarges the ventricles and may increase intracranial pressure.

**Water Retention**

Excess accumulation of fluid in the body's tissues or cavities, commonly causing swelling and sometimes resulting from heart, kidney, liver, venous, hormonal, or medication-related disorders.

**Waterborne Bacterial Disease**

A clinical condition involving waterborne Bacterial Disease; its causes, manifestations, severity, and complications guide diagnosis and management.

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## WBS

WBS is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly Williams-Beuren syndrome, a genetic condition with characteristic facial features, developmental differences, and cardiovascular disease.

## WDWN

WDWN is a medical abbreviation for well developed, well nourished, commonly used in physical examination documentation.

## Weaver's Bottom

Inflammation of the ischial bursa over the sitting bone, causing pain in the buttock that may worsen with prolonged sitting. It is also called ischial bursitis.

## Welt

A raised, often itchy area of skin caused by localized swelling, commonly seen in hives or after an insect bite. A welt may fade within hours, but persistent or severe reactions need evaluation.

## WF

WF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including white female in demographic shorthand or waveform in technical settings; clearer wording is preferred.

## Wharton's Jelly

Gelatinous connective tissue within the umbilical cord that surrounds and supports the umbilical blood vessels and helps protect them from compression.

## Whipworm

A parasitic roundworm of the genus *Trichuris*, usually *Trichuris trichiura* in humans. Infection occurs by ingesting embryonated eggs and may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, anemia, or rectal prolapse when severe.

## WHO (World Health Organization)

The World Health Organization is a United Nations agency that coordinates international health work, standards, surveillance, and emergency response.

## Wing Bone

A bone forming the skeletal framework of a bird or bat wing; it is not a standard human anatomical term, though the bones correspond broadly to the upper limb.

## Witch's Milk

A temporary milky breast discharge in a newborn caused by maternal hormones crossing the placenta; it usually resolves without squeezing or treatment, which can otherwise cause infection.

## WM

WM is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly white matter or Waldenström macroglobulinemia; the complete term should be specified.

## WNL

WNL is an abbreviation for within normal limits, meaning a finding falls within the reference range or expected clinical appearance.

## Women's Hospital

A biomedical term referring to women's Hospital; its defining features and medical significance depend on the relevant biologic or clinical context.

## World Health Organization

World Health Organization is a biological, genetic, biochemical, or chemical term used in medicine; its significance depends on its structure, function, concentration, pathway, or clinical context.

## Wt

A medical abbreviation commonly meaning weight. Its meaning should be confirmed from the surrounding documentation because abbreviations can be ambiguous.

## Wet Gangrene

Tissue death complicated by bacterial infection and tissue swelling, producing moist, discolored, rapidly spreading necrosis. It requires urgent medical assessment.

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### **Wheal And Flare**

A transient raised area of dermal edema (wheal) surrounded by localized redness (flare), typically produced by histamine release in urticaria or another immediate hypersensitivity reaction.

### **Whole-Bowel Irrigation**

Gastrointestinal decontamination using large volumes of an iso-osmotic polyethylene-glycol solution to flush intestinal contents; it is reserved for selected ingestions and requires airway and clinical assessment.

### **Wound Management**

Assessment and treatment of acute or chronic wounds through cleansing, debridement when indicated, moisture and exudate control, infection management, pressure relief, nutrition, and correction of underlying disease.





# X

## X Chromosome

One of the two human sex chromosomes, carrying genes involved in sex development and many non-sex-specific biological functions. Individuals typically have one or two X chromosomes, and dosage is partly regulated by X-chromosome inactivation.

## XXX Syndrome

Alternate index label; see *Triple X syndrome* (trisomy X), a sex-chromosome variation in which a female has an additional X chromosome.

## X-Inactivation

Process inactivating one X chromosome in female mammals, forming Barr body. Occurs early in development, random in most tissues. Ensures dosage compensation.

## X-Linked Agammaglobulinemia

An inherited immunodeficiency, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in the BTK gene, that prevents normal B-cell maturation. It causes very low immunoglobulin levels and recurrent bacterial or enteroviral infections, usually beginning in infancy or early childhood.

## X-Linked Inheritance

Transmission of a pathogenic variant on the X chromosome. Phenotypes differ by sex, X-inactivation, and variant mechanism; fathers do not transmit an X-linked variant to their sons.

## X-Linked Retinoschisis

An inherited vitreoretinal dystrophy caused by mutations in the RS1 gene, characterized by splitting of the retinal nerve fibre layer producing a spoke-

wheel pattern of cystic spaces at the macula and peripheral retinal schisis.

## X-Ray

An X-ray is an imaging study that passes a small amount of ionizing radiation through the body to create a projection image. Differences in tissue density help show bones, lungs, teeth, and selected soft-tissue abnormalities.

## X-Ray (Plain Radiography)

An imaging method that uses X-rays to create a two-dimensional projection of internal structures. It is used to assess bones, the chest, abdomen, teeth, and other selected body regions.

### Synonyms:

Plain Radiography

## X-Ray (Radiography)

Projectional imaging using ionizing radiation. Dense structures (bone, contrast) appear white; air appears black. Fast, inexpensive, widely available. Two-dimensional projection of three-dimensional structures. Mammography: specialized breast X-ray for screening.

### Synonyms:

Radiography

## X-Ray Attenuation

Reduction in the intensity of an X-ray beam as it passes through tissue or another material.

## X-Ray Shield

Lead apron, thyroid shield for radiation protection during imaging.

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## X-Rays (Röntgen Rays)

Electromagnetic radiation used in radiography and other imaging techniques to create images by measuring differences in tissue attenuation.

### Synonyms:

Röntgen Rays

## Xanthelasma

Xanthelasma palpebrarum are soft, yellow, lipid-filled papules or plaques on the medial canthus of the eyelids (upper more commonly than lower), the most common form of cutaneous xanthoma. They are composed of foam cells (lipid-laden macrophages) in the superficial dermis.

## Xanthine Oxidase Inhibitor

A class of medications that inhibit xanthine oxidase, the enzyme that catalyzes the final steps of purine metabolism: hypoxanthine to xanthine and xanthine to uric acid. By inhibiting this enzyme, XOIs reduce uric acid production and lower serum uric acid levels, used for management of chronic gout and tumor lysis syndrome.

## Xanthogranulomatous

Chronic destructive renal infection with replacement of parenchyma by lipid-laden macrophages. See xanthogranulomatous pyelonephritis.

## Xanthogranulomatous Pyelonephritis

A chronic destructive kidney infection in which renal tissue is replaced by lipid-laden macrophages. It is often associated with obstruction or stones and may require antibiotics, drainage, surgery, or nephrectomy depending on the extent of damage.

## Xanthoma

A xanthoma is a yellowish deposit of lipid-laden macrophages in the skin, subcutaneous tissue, or tendons. It may occur with hyperlipidemia, diabetes, cholestatic liver disease, or an inherited lipid disorder and warrants assessment of the underlying cause. presenting as yellow-orange papules, nodules, or plaques.

## Xanthomatosis

A disorder in which fatty deposits called xanthomas develop in the skin, tendons, or organs. It may be associated with inherited or acquired lipid disorders and can signal increased cardiovascular or organ-specific risk requiring medical evaluation.

## Xenobiotic

Foreign chemical substance in body. Drugs, pollutants, pesticides, industrial chemicals. Metabolized by liver enzymes.

## Xenograft

Tissue or a biological material transplanted between different species, often used as a temporary graft or tissue substitute.

## Xenograft (Heterograft)

A surgical graft taken from a donor of a different species (xenos = foreign, Greek). Xenografts are used as temporary biological dressings or as tissue replacements.

### Synonyms:

Heterograft

## Xeroderma

Abnormally dry skin that may cause scaling, roughness, itching, or cracking. It can result from environmental exposure, skin disease, age, or medicines.

## Xeroderma Pigmentosum

A rare autosomal recessive disorder of nucleotide-excision DNA repair that causes extreme sun sensitivity and a greatly increased risk of skin and eye damage and cancers. It is caused by pathogenic variants in genes involved in DNA repair.

## Xenophobia

An intense or persistent fear of unfamiliar people, cultures, or situations; when clinically significant, it may be considered a specific phobia.

## Xerophthalmia

Dryness of the conjunctiva and cornea, often caused by vitamin A deficiency. Severe disease can damage

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the cornea and impair vision.

### **Xerosis**

Abnormally dry skin, common in elderly patients and winter months. It results from decreased sebaceous and sweat gland activity, impaired skin barrier function, and environmental factors. Treatment includes regular emollient application (cream or ointment rather than lotion), gentle cleansing, and humidification.

### **Xerostomia**

The sensation of dry mouth caused by reduced or altered saliva production. It may result from medicines, dehydration, salivary-gland disease, radiation, or systemic illness and can impair speaking, swallowing, taste, and dental health.

### **Xerostomia (Dry Mouth)**

A subjective sensation of oral dryness caused by reduced or altered saliva production. It may result from medicines, dehydration, salivary-gland disease, radiation, or systemic illness and can contribute to difficulty speaking, swallowing, and dental decay.

#### **Synonyms:**

Dry Mouth

### **Xylitol Toxicity**

Poisoning caused by excessive xylitol exposure. It can cause marked hypoglycemia in dogs and may cause gastrointestinal symptoms in people.

### **X-Linked Adrenoleukodystrophy**

An inherited disorder of peroxisomal fatty-acid metabolism, usually affecting boys, that can cause progressive damage to the adrenal glands, nervous system, and myelin.

### **X-Linked Ichthyosis**

An inherited skin disorder caused by deficiency of steroid sulfatase, producing generalized dry, dark, plate-like scaling that often begins in infancy or early childhood.

### **X-Linked Severe Combined**

### **Immunodeficiency**

A severe inherited immune disorder, usually caused by defects affecting the interleukin-2 receptor gamma chain, resulting in profound T-cell dysfunction and vulnerability to serious infections.

### **X-Linked Hypophosphatemia**

An inherited disorder of phosphate regulation, commonly caused by excess fibroblast growth factor 23, leading to renal phosphate wasting, rickets or osteomalacia, bone pain, and growth abnormalities.

### **XYY Syndrome**

A sex-chromosome variation in which a male has an extra Y chromosome. Many affected individuals have few or no obvious symptoms, though some have tall stature, learning difficulties, or developmental differences.

### **Xanthine**

Purine base intermediate in uric acid metabolism; accumulated in xanthinuria due to xanthine oxidase deficiency.

### **Xanthine Dehydrogenase**

Enzyme converting hypoxanthine to xanthine and xanthine to uric acid; deficiency causes xanthinuria type I.

### **Xanthine Oxidase**

Molybdenum-containing enzyme catalyzing oxidation of hypoxanthine to xanthine and xanthine to uric acid; target of allopurinol in gout treatment.

### **Xanthomonadaceae**

Family of Gram-negative, aerobic, rod-shaped bacteria; includes plant pathogens and rare human opportunistic isolates.

### **Xanthomonas**

Genus of Gram-negative, aerobic bacteria in family Xanthomonadaceae; primarily plant pathogens, occasionally isolated from clinical specimens.

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### **Xenobiotic Metabolism**

Biotransformation of foreign chemical compounds (drugs, toxins, pollutants) primarily by hepatic cytochrome P450 enzymes; Phase I and Phase II reactions.

### **Xenograft Procedure**

Transplantation of tissue between different species; used experimentally and clinically (e.g., porcine heart valves, skin grafts).

### **Xenon**

Noble gas (Xe) with anesthetic properties; used in research imaging and experimental anesthesia.

### **Xenophagy**

Cellular process of degrading engulfed foreign material or pathogens via autophagy machinery.

### **Xipamide**

Thiazide-like diuretic used for hypertension and edema; acts on the distal convoluted tubule.

### **X-Ray Crystallography**

Analytical technique using X-ray diffraction patterns to determine three-dimensional atomic structure of crystals and proteins.

### **X-Ray Therapy**

Use of ionizing radiation from X-ray sources for treatment of malignant and benign conditions; encompasses external beam radiotherapy.

### **Xylose**

Five-carbon monosaccharide used in diagnostic tests for intestinal absorption (D-xylose test) and bacterial metabolism studies.

### **X-Ray - Skeleton**

A skeletal X-ray series uses radiographs of selected bones and joints to evaluate fractures, alignment, bone density patterns, arthritis, infection, tumors, and developmental abnormalities.

### **X, Factor**

Factor X is a vitamin-K-dependent coagulation protein activated in the common pathway to generate thrombin and form fibrin.

### **Xanth- (Prefix)**

Xanth- is a medical word element meaning yellow or yellowish, as in xanthoma, xanthelasma, and xanthopsia.

### **Xanthopsia**

A visual disturbance in which objects appear yellow or yellowish. It can occur with certain eye disorders, medication toxicity such as digoxin toxicity, or other neurologic or retinal conditions and warrants evaluation when new or persistent.

### **Xanthosis**

Yellow discoloration of tissues caused by deposition of carotenoid pigments or other yellow material, distinguished from jaundice by the absence of yellowing in the sclerae.

### **Xen- (Prefix)**

A medical word element meaning foreign, strange, or originating outside the usual organism or system, as in xenograft (a tissue transplanted between different species).

### **Xeno- (Prefix)**

Xeno- is a medical word element meaning foreign, strange, or from another species, as in xenograft and xenotransplantation.

### **Xero-**

Xero- is a medical word element meaning dry or dryness, as in xeroderma, xerophthalmia, and xerostomia.

### **XRT**

XRT is an abbreviation for radiation therapy, the use of ionizing radiation to treat cancer or selected other diseases.

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## XX

XX is the usual human sex-chromosome complement associated with female development, though sex development has biologic variation.

## XX Male Syndrome

XX male syndrome, also called de la Chapelle syndrome, is a disorder of sex development in which a person with an XX karyotype develops a typically male phenotype, usually from translocation of the SRY gene; infertility is common.

## XXXX Syndrome

XXXX syndrome is a rare sex-chromosome variation in which a female has four X chromosomes; it may cause developmental or learning difficulties, distinctive physical features, and ovarian dysfunction, with severity varying widely.

## Xanthomata

Multiple xanthomas: yellowish deposits of lipid-laden macrophages in the skin, tendons, or other tissues, sometimes associated with lipid disorders or cholestatic disease.

## Xenotransplant

Transplantation of cells, tissues, or organs between different species, such as experimental or clinical use of animal-derived biological material.

## Xiphisternal Plane

The horizontal anatomical plane at the junction of the body of the sternum and the xiphoid process, approximately corresponding to the T9 vertebral level.

## Xiphoid Process

The small inferior projection of the sternum. Its shape varies, and it serves as an attachment site for muscles and ligaments.

## X-Linked

Relating to a gene or condition associated with the X chromosome; inheritance patterns differ between individuals with one or two X chromosomes.

## X-Rays

Penetrating electromagnetic radiation used in radiography and some forms of radiotherapy; ionizing exposure can damage tissue, so clinical use is justified and optimized.

## Xylitol

A sugar alcohol used as a sweetener and in some oral-care products. Large human ingestions may cause gastrointestinal symptoms; it is highly toxic to dogs.

## Xanthogranulomatous Oophoritis

A rare chronic inflammatory lesion of the ovary with lipid-laden macrophages, plasma cells, and fibrosis, often associated with infection or endometriosis and capable of mimicking ovarian malignancy.

## Xenotransplantation

The transplantation of living cells, tissues, or organs between members of different species, most commonly from an animal donor to a human recipient. It is being investigated as a potential source of organs and tissues when human donor supply is insufficient, but substantial immunologic and infectious risks remain. Major concerns include hyperacute or delayed rejection, graft dysfunction, transmission of animal pathogens, and physiologic incompatibility. Clinical use or research requires rigorous immunologic screening, infection surveillance, ethical oversight, and specialized monitoring of recipients.





# Y

## Y Chromosome

The sex chromosome that typically carries the SRY gene and other genes involved in testicular development and male sex differentiation. It is present in most individuals with a typical 46,XY karyotype and is transmitted through the paternal line.

## Yohimbine

A plant-derived alkaloid that has been studied for erectile dysfunction and other uses.

## YAG Capsulotomy

A laser procedure that creates an opening in an opaque posterior lens capsule after cataract surgery. It can improve vision when posterior capsule opacification is causing visual symptoms.

## Yaws

Yaws is a chronic infection caused by *Treponema pallidum* subsp. *pertenue* and spread mainly through close skin contact. It can cause an initial papilloma or ulcer and later destructive lesions of skin, bone, and cartilage; antibiotics can cure the infection.

## Yaws (Frambesia)

A chronic, non-venereal treponematoses caused by *Treponema pallidum* subspecies *pertenue*, closely related to the syphilis spirochete (*T. pallidum pallidum*).

### Synonyms:

Frambesia

## Yeast

Yeasts are unicellular fungi that reproduce mainly by budding or, in some species, fission; medically important examples include *Candida*, *Cryptococcus*,

and *Malassezia*, which may colonize humans or cause opportunistic infection.

## Yeast Infection

Vulvovaginal candidiasis: infection by *Candida albicans* (most common), causing vulvar and vaginal itching, burning, thick white 'cottage cheese' discharge, dyspareunia, and erythema; more common in pregnancy, diabetes, antibiotic use, and immunosuppression. Diagnosis: clinical; wet mount (budding yeast/hyphae), KOH, or culture.

## Yellow Fever

Yellow fever is an acute mosquito-borne infection caused by yellow fever virus. Fever, headache, muscle aches, nausea, and vomiting may be followed by jaundice, bleeding, shock, and organ failure; vaccination is the main preventive measure.

## Yellow-Nail Syndrome

A rare triad of yellow, thickened, slow-growing nails, lymphedema, and chronic respiratory disease including bronchiectasis and pleural effusions. The nail changes result from impaired lymphatic drainage affecting nail growth. It typically affects middle-aged adults.

## Yersinia Enterocolitica

A gram-negative coccobacillus of the family Enterobacteriaceae, a common cause of enterocolitis and mesenteric lymphadenitis, especially in children and young adults in temperate climates.

## Yersinia Infection

Infection caused by *Yersinia* bacteria, commonly producing diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or vom-

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iting. Some cases mimic appendicitis; severe illness, dehydration, bloody diarrhea, or persistent symptoms requires medical assessment.

### **Yersinia Pestis**

A gram-negative rod that causes plague, a severe and potentially fatal infection; see *Plague*. The organism is transmitted by flea bites or direct contact with infected animals. Bubonic plague presents with painful lymphadenopathy (buboes). Pneumonic plague involves the lungs and is transmitted by respiratory droplets.

### **Yolk Sac**

An extraembryonic structure that supports the early embryo before the placenta is fully functional. It contributes to early blood-cell formation and development of the primitive gut and is assessed on early pregnancy ultrasound.

### **Yolk-Sac Tumor**

A malignant germ-cell tumor that commonly occurs in children and produces alpha-fetoprotein.

### **Yttrium-90**

Beta emitter, half-life 64 hours. Used in radioembolization (Y-90 microspheres) for liver cancer. Bremsstrahlung imaging possible.

### **Yips**

Sudden involuntary movements or muscle spasms that interfere with a skilled task, often in athletes or musicians.

### **Yergason Test**

A shoulder examination maneuver used to assess the long head of the biceps tendon and transverse humeral ligament by resisted supination and external rotation.

### **Yersiniosis**

Infection caused by *Yersinia* bacteria, most often *Y. enterocolitica* or *Y. pseudotuberculosis*, producing diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or pseudoappendicitis.

### **YAG Laser Capsulotomy**

A laser procedure that creates an opening in a cloudy posterior lens capsule after cataract surgery, restoring the passage of light and improving vision.

### **Yarrowia**

A genus of yeast that can rarely cause opportunistic infection, particularly in people who are immunocompromised or have indwelling medical devices. Identification and treatment depend on species and susceptibility testing.

### **Yarrowia Lipolytica**

A yeast species in the genus *Yarrowia* that is primarily environmental but has rarely been reported as an opportunistic human pathogen, including bloodstream or device-associated infection.

### **Yawn**

An involuntary behavior consisting of a deep inhalation followed by a slower exhalation, often with stretching of the jaw and facial muscles. Yawning is common with fatigue but excessive or unusual yawning can occur with some medications or neurologic conditions.

### **Yeast Present**

A laboratory report indicating that yeast forms were detected in a specimen. The finding may represent colonization, contamination, or infection and must be interpreted with symptoms, specimen type, and organism identification.

### **Yellow Fever Virus**

yellow fever virus is a virus or viral group classified by its genetic and biologic features. Clinical importance depends on the strain, host, route of transmission, tissue tropism, and ability to cause disease.

### **Yersinia**

*Yersinia* is a genus of Gram-negative bacteria that includes *Y. pestis*, *Y. enterocolitica*, and *Y. pseudotuberculosis*; human disease ranges from enterocolitis and pseudoappendicitis to plague.

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### **Yersinia Aldovae**

yersinia aldovae is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Bercovieri**

yersinia bercovieri is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Frederiksenii**

yersinia frederiksenii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Intermedia**

yersinia intermedia is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Kristensenii**

yersinia kristensenii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Mollaretii**

yersinia mollaretii is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Pseudotuberculosis**

Yersinia pseudotuberculosis is a Gram-negative bacterium acquired mainly from contaminated food or water that causes enterocolitis, fever, and mesenteric

lymphadenitis resembling appendicitis; systemic infection is uncommon.

### **Yersinia Rohdei**

yersinia rohdei is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yersinia Ruckeri**

yersinia ruckeri is a microorganism or microbial group identified by its biologic and taxonomic features. Clinical significance depends on pathogenicity, exposure, the site involved, and antimicrobial susceptibility.

### **Yoga**

A mind-body practice combining physical postures, breathing techniques, and meditation or relaxation. It may support flexibility, balance, stress reduction, and symptom management, but exercises should be adapted to individual health conditions.

### **Yokenella**

A genus of Gram-negative bacteria in the family Enterobacteriales. Yokenella species are uncommon human pathogens but can cause opportunistic infections, including wound or bloodstream infections.

### **Yokenella Regensburgei**

A Gram-negative bacterium that rarely causes human infection, including wound, urinary, or bloodstream infection, usually in people with underlying illness or impaired immunity. Treatment is guided by culture and antimicrobial susceptibility results.

### **Ytterbium**

A chemical element with the symbol Yb and atomic number 70. Its compounds have specialized industrial and research uses; medical relevance depends on the specific compound and exposure.

### **Yttrium**

A chemical element with the symbol Y and atomic

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number 39. The radioactive isotope yttrium-90 is used in selected radiation treatments, including some targeted therapies and radiosynovectomy procedures.

### **Yellow Tongue**

Yellow discoloration or coating of the tongue that may result from oral hygiene, smoking, dry mouth, diet, medicines, or an underlying illness.

### **Yawning - Excessive**

Excessive yawning is unusually frequent or difficult-to-control yawning. It may accompany sleep deprivation, excessive daytime sleepiness, medication effects, vasovagal reactions, or less commonly neurologic or cardiopulmonary disease; persistent unexplained episodes merit clinical evaluation.

### **Yew Poisoning**

Yew poisoning follows ingestion of yew plant material, especially leaves or seeds containing taxine compounds. Toxicity can cause nausea, abdominal symptoms, dizziness, seizures, dangerous slowing or disruption of the heart rhythm, cardiovascular collapse, and death.

### **Yoga For Health**

Yoga for health combines physical postures, breathing exercises, and meditation or relaxation. It may improve flexibility, balance, strength, stress, and some chronic symptoms when adapted to the person; instructors should account for injuries, pregnancy, and medical limitations.

### **Your Baby And The Flu**

Infants with influenza can develop fever, cough, poor feeding, vomiting, diarrhea, breathing difficulty, or unusual sleepiness. Care focuses on prompt medical advice, hydration, monitoring for respiratory distress, and age-appropriate antiviral treatment when indicated; influenza vaccination is preventive for eligible family members and children.

### **Your Baby In The Birth Canal**

A baby in the birth canal is progressing through the maternal pelvis during labor. Clinicians assess

fetal position, descent, heart rate, and the progress of cervical dilation to identify normal vaginal-birth progress or complications requiring intervention.

### **Your Cancer Care Team**

A cancer care team is the group of oncology professionals who coordinate diagnosis, treatment, symptom control, rehabilitation, psychosocial support, and follow-up. It may include medical, surgical, and radiation oncologists, nurses, pharmacists, social workers, dietitians, and palliative-care specialists.

### **Your Cancer Diagnosis - Do You Need A Second Opinion?**

A second opinion after a cancer diagnosis is an independent review of pathology, imaging, staging, and treatment options by another qualified clinician or cancer center. It can confirm the diagnosis, identify alternatives, and help the patient make an informed treatment decision without usually delaying urgent care.

### **Your Cancer Survivorship Care Plan**

A cancer survivorship care plan summarizes completed treatment, possible late effects, recommended surveillance, preventive care, rehabilitation, and communication between oncology and primary-care clinicians. It is updated as health needs change after active treatment.

### **Your Child And The Flu**

Children with influenza may have fever, cough, sore throat, fatigue, headache, muscle aches, vomiting, or diarrhea. Supportive care includes fluids and symptom monitoring; urgent assessment is needed for breathing difficulty, dehydration, confusion, severe weakness, or worsening after improvement.

### **Your Child's First Vaccines - What You Need To Know**

A child's first vaccines stimulate protection against serious infections according to the recommended immunization schedule. Clinicians review timing, contraindications, expected local or systemic reactions, catch-up options, and when urgent care is needed for a severe reaction.

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## **Your Diet After Gastric Bypass Surgery**

Diet after gastric bypass surgery progresses from liquids to pureed, soft, and regular-textured foods in small portions as healing permits. Long-term care emphasizes protein, fluids separated from meals, vitamin and mineral supplements, avoidance of dumping-triggering foods, and monitoring for nutritional deficiencies.

## **Yeast Infection In Women And Men**

Genital yeast infection is usually caused by *Candida* and can cause itching, soreness, redness, and thick discharge in women or irritation and rash on the penis in men. Recurrent, severe, atypical, or treatment-resistant symptoms need confirmation and evaluation for contributing conditions.

### **Synonyms:**

Candidal Vulvovaginitis (Yeast Infection In Women And Men)

## **Yeast Infections: How Do You Know When It Heals**

A yeast infection is generally improving when itching, soreness, redness, and abnormal discharge resolve and do not return after treatment. Persistent symptoms may reflect resistant yeast, another infection, dermatitis, or an incorrect diagnosis and warrant examination rather than repeated empiric treatment.

## **Yeast Oral (Thrush)**

Alternate index label for Thrush.

## **Younger Children Sleep (Sleep And Sleep Disorders In Children And Teens)**

Alternate index label for Sleep and Sleep Disorders in Children and Teens.

## **Y-Linked Inheritance**

Y-linked inheritance involves a gene on the Y chromosome and typically passes from an affected father to his sons, not daughters.

## **YAG Laser Surgery**

YAG laser surgery uses a yttrium-aluminum-garnet

laser to cut, vaporize, or treat tissue, including posterior-capsule clouding after cataract surgery.

## **Yawning**

Repeated involuntary opening of the mouth with a deep inhalation and subsequent exhalation. It is usually associated with sleepiness or boredom; persistent excessive yawning may warrant assessment for medication effects or an underlying disorder.

## **Yd.**

An abbreviation for yard, a unit of length equal to 0.9144 meter. In clinical documentation, the unit should be written clearly to avoid confusion with other abbreviations.

## **Yolk Stalk**

The embryonic connection between the yolk sac and the developing midgut, also called the vitelline duct. Persistence of this structure can result in a Meckel diverticulum or other vitelline duct anomaly.

## **Yeast Infection (Vaginal)**

An overgrowth of *Candida* in the vagina causing itching, irritation, redness, and thick white discharge.

### **Synonyms:**

Candidiasis, Vaginal Vaginal Candidiasis

## **Yellow Nail Syndrome**

A rare disorder characterized by slow-growing yellow dystrophic nails, chronic lymphedema, and respiratory disease. Nail changes may include thickening, excessive curvature, loss of the cuticle, and separation of the nail plate from the nail bed. Respiratory manifestations can include recurrent sinusitis, chronic cough, pleural effusions, or bronchiectasis, although the complete triad is not always present. Diagnosis is clinical and supported by characteristic nail findings and evaluation for lymphatic or pulmonary complications; management is directed at the affected systems.





## Z

### Z-Plasty

A reconstructive surgical technique that uses interconnected triangular skin flaps in a Z-shaped arrangement to lengthen a contracted scar and change its direction. It is used in selected scar contractures and other soft-tissue deformities.

### Zafirlukast

A leukotriene-receptor antagonist used for long-term control and prevention of asthma symptoms. It is taken orally and is not a rescue treatment for an acute asthma attack; liver injury and drug interactions are important safety considerations.

### Zalcitabine

A nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor formerly used in combination antiretroviral treatment for HIV infection. It is rarely used because of toxicity and the availability of safer alternatives; peripheral neuropathy and pancreatitis are important adverse effects.

### Zollinger-Ellison Syndrome

A disorder caused by one or more gastrin-secreting neuroendocrine tumors, called gastrinomas, that produce marked gastric acid hypersecretion. Excess acid commonly causes recurrent or multiple peptic ulcers, gastroesophageal reflux, abdominal pain, and secretory diarrhea. Gastrinomas may arise in the duodenum or pancreas and can occur as part of multiple endocrine neoplasia type 1. Diagnosis uses fasting serum gastrin with assessment of gastric acidity, followed by localization and staging of the tumor when appropriate.

#### Synonyms:

ddC

### Zanamivir

An inhaled neuraminidase inhibitor used to treat or prevent influenza A and B when started appropriately. It may cause bronchospasm and is used cautiously in people with underlying airway disease.

#### Synonyms:

Relenza

### Zavanelli Maneuver

A rare emergency maneuver for unresolved shoulder dystocia in which the fetal head is flexed and replaced into the birth canal before emergency cesarean delivery. It is performed only by an experienced obstetric team when other measures have failed.

#### Synonyms:

cephalic replacement

### Zebrafish

A small freshwater fish (*Danio rerio*) widely used as a laboratory model in developmental biology, genetics, toxicology, and disease research. Its embryos are transparent and develop rapidly, but findings may not translate directly to humans.

#### Synonyms:

*Danio rerio*

### Zellweger Syndrome

A severe inherited peroxisome-biogenesis disorder, usually caused by pathogenic variants in a PEX gene. It presents in infancy with hypotonia, seizures, feeding difficulty, liver dysfunction, distinctive facial features, and impaired brain development.

#### Synonyms:

Zellweger spectrum disorder

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### Zenker Diverticulum

A pouch that protrudes through the muscular wall at the upper esophagus, usually between the inferior pharyngeal constrictor and cricopharyngeus muscles. It can cause dysphagia, regurgitation of undigested food, halitosis, cough, and aspiration; barium esophagography is commonly diagnostic.

**Synonyms:**

Zenker's diverticulum

### Ziehl-Neelsen Stain

An acid-fast staining method that helps detect organisms with waxy cell walls, especially mycobacteria. Acid-fast organisms retain carbol fuchsin after acid-alcohol decolorization and appear red against a contrasting background.

**Synonyms:**

acid-fast stain

### Zibotentan

An investigational selective endothelin-A-receptor antagonist studied mainly in oncology. It is not an established routine treatment, and its clinical role depends on evidence from clinical trials and regulatory approval.

### Ziconotide

A synthetic analog of omega-conotoxin used by continuous intrathecal infusion for severe chronic pain when other treatments are inadequate. It can cause dizziness, confusion, hallucinations, and other serious neurologic or psychiatric adverse effects.

**Synonyms:**

Prialt

### Zieve Syndrome

A complication of acute alcohol-associated liver injury characterized by hemolytic anemia, transient hyperlipidemia, and jaundice. Treatment focuses on stopping alcohol use and managing the associated liver disease and complications.

**Synonyms:**

Zieve's syndrome

### Zidovudine

A nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor used in selected antiretroviral regimens for HIV infection and to reduce perinatal HIV transmission. Bone-marrow suppression, anemia, neutropenia, myopathy, and mitochondrial toxicity are important adverse effects.

**Synonyms:**

azidothymidine; AZT

### Zika

An illness caused by Zika virus, usually producing no symptoms or a mild fever, rash, conjunctivitis, arthralgia, and myalgia. Infection during pregnancy can cause congenital Zika syndrome, and infection has also been associated with Guillain-Barré syndrome.

**Synonyms:**

Zika virus disease

### Zika Virus

A positive-sense RNA flavivirus transmitted mainly by infected *Aedes* mosquitoes and also by sexual contact and other less common routes. Infection is often asymptomatic or mild, but infection during pregnancy can injure the developing fetus.

**Synonyms:**

ZIKV

### Zileuton

A 5-lipoxygenase inhibitor used for prevention and chronic control of asthma. It does not relieve acute bronchospasm; liver-enzyme elevations and interactions with other medicines require monitoring.

**Synonyms:**

Zyflo

### Zinc

An essential trace mineral required for numerous enzymes, gene-regulatory proteins, immune functions, growth, reproduction, and wound healing. Excess supplementation can cause gastrointestinal symptoms and copper deficiency.

**Synonyms:**

Zn

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### **Zinc Acetate**

An oral zinc salt used to treat zinc deficiency and, in specific formulations, to reduce intestinal copper absorption in Wilson disease. Dose and monitoring depend on the indication; nausea and gastrointestinal irritation may occur.

### **Zinc Deficiency**

A state of inadequate available zinc caused by insufficient intake, malabsorption, excessive losses, or increased requirements. Manifestations may include impaired growth, dermatitis, alopecia, diarrhea, altered taste, delayed wound healing, and increased infection susceptibility.

#### **Synonyms:**

zinc depletion

### **Zinc Oxide**

An insoluble zinc compound used topically as a skin protectant and barrier, including in preparations for diaper dermatitis and minor irritation. It can reduce contact with moisture and irritants but does not treat every cause of a rash.

#### **Synonyms:**

ZnO

### **Zinc Ointment (Zinc Oxide)**

A topical preparation containing zinc oxide that forms a protective barrier over irritated or moist skin. It is commonly used for diaper dermatitis and minor skin irritation.

#### **Synonyms:**

zinc oxide ointment

### **Zinc Sulfate**

An oral or parenteral zinc salt used to prevent or treat zinc deficiency when clinically indicated. Gastrointestinal upset is common with oral therapy, and prolonged excessive use can cause copper deficiency.

### **Zinc Toxicity**

Adverse effects caused by excessive zinc ingestion or exposure. Acute toxicity may cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea; chronic excess can impair copper absorption and lead to anemia

or neurologic and immune abnormalities.

#### **Synonyms:**

zinc poisoning

### **Zingiber Officinale**

The botanical species commonly known as ginger. Rhizome preparations are used as a flavoring and may provide modest relief of nausea in some settings; gastrointestinal irritation and drug interactions, including effects on bleeding risk, are possible.

#### **Synonyms:**

ginger

### **Zinostatin**

An antitumor antibiotic, also called neocarzinostatin, that damages DNA. It has been used or studied in oncology in some countries and settings; availability, indications, and toxicity depend on the specific formulation and regulatory status.

#### **Synonyms:**

neocarzinostatin

### **Zirconia**

A zirconium-oxide ceramic used in dentistry for crowns, bridges, implants, and other restorations. Its strength and tissue compatibility make it useful, although restoration design, surface treatment, and clinical indication affect performance.

#### **Synonyms:**

zirconium dioxide

### **Zirconium**

A metallic element used in some medical and dental materials. Certain zirconium-containing compounds have specialized clinical uses, while exposure to some compounds can irritate tissues or produce systemic toxicity.

#### **Synonyms:**

Zr

### **Zoledronic Acid**

A potent intravenous bisphosphonate used for osteoporosis and certain cancer-related conditions, including hypercalcemia of malignancy and skeletal complications of bone metastases. Renal injury,

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hypocalcemia, acute-phase reactions, and rare osteonecrosis of the jaw are important risks.

**Synonyms:**

zoledronate; Reclast; Zometa

**Zolpidem**

A nonbenzodiazepine sedative-hypnotic used for short-term treatment of insomnia. It can cause next-day impairment, complex sleep behaviors, dependence, and respiratory or central-nervous-system depression, especially with other sedatives.

**Synonyms:**

Ambien

**Zolpidem Tartrate**

The tartrate salt of zolpidem, formulated as an oral sedative-hypnotic for insomnia. It carries the same risks as zolpidem, including next-day impairment, abnormal sleep behaviors, dependence, and additive sedation.

**Zona Pellucida**

A glycoprotein-rich extracellular layer surrounding the mammalian oocyte. It participates in sperm binding and the acrosome reaction and helps prevent polyspermy after fertilization.

**Synonyms:**

oocyte zona pellucida

**Zonisamide**

An antiseizure medicine used for focal-onset seizures and, in some countries, other seizure indications. It can cause somnolence, cognitive effects, metabolic acidosis, kidney stones, oligohydrosis, and serious hypersensitivity reactions.

**Synonyms:**

Zonegran

**Zonula Adherens**

A belt-like cell junction that links the actin cytoskeletons of adjacent epithelial cells. It contributes to cell adhesion and helps maintain epithelial structure and barrier organization.

**Synonyms:**

adherens junction; zonula adherente

**Zonule**

Fibrous suspensory fibers connecting the ciliary body to the lens capsule. They transmit forces from the ciliary muscle and help alter lens curvature during accommodation.

**Synonyms:**

zonular fibers; ciliary zonule

**Zonules**

The plural of zonule; in ophthalmology, usually the suspensory fibers that support the crystalline lens. Weak or disrupted zonules can contribute to lens subluxation and complicate cataract surgery.

**Synonyms:**

zonular fibers

**Zoon Balanitis**

A chronic benign inflammation of the glans penis, usually seen in uncircumcised men. It commonly appears as a sharply demarcated shiny orange-red or rust-colored patch; diagnosis is clinical, with biopsy used when the diagnosis is uncertain.

**Synonyms:**

plasma cell balanitis; balanitis circumscripta plasmacellularis

**Zoonotic Disease**

An infectious disease that can be naturally transmitted between vertebrate animals and humans. Transmission may occur through direct contact, contaminated food or water, animal products, or arthropod vectors.

**Synonyms:**

zoonosis

**Zoonosis**

An infection naturally transmissible between vertebrate animals and humans. Examples include rabies, brucellosis, leptospirosis, psittacosis, toxoplasmosis, and some influenza infections.

**Synonyms:**

zoonotic disease

**Zoophobia**

A specific phobia involving excessive or persistent

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fear of animals that causes clinically significant distress or avoidance. Treatment may include cognitive-behavioral therapy with exposure; medication may be considered for selected patients.

**Synonyms:**

animal phobia

**Zoster**

A painful, usually unilateral vesicular eruption caused by reactivation of latent varicella-zoster virus in a sensory nerve ganglion. It may be complicated by postherpetic neuralgia, ocular disease, or neurologic involvement.

**Synonyms:**

shingles; herpes zoster

**Zygoma (Zygomatic Bone)**

A paired facial bone that forms the prominence of the cheek and part of the lateral orbital wall and floor. It articulates with the frontal, sphenoid, temporal, and maxillary bones.

**Synonyms:**

zygomatic bone; cheekbone

**Zygomatic Fracture**

A fracture of the zygomatic bone or zygomaticomaxillary complex, usually caused by facial trauma. It may cause facial flattening, infraorbital numbness, diplopia, trismus, or orbital injury.

**Synonyms:**

zygomaticomaxillary complex fracture

**Zygomatic Gland**

In veterinary anatomy, the zygomatic gland is an orbital gland that contributes to the tear film, especially in dogs and cats; it is distinct from the human lacrimal gland and should be interpreted according to species-specific anatomy.

**Zygomycosis**

An older term for invasive fungal infection caused by organisms formerly grouped as zygomycetes, particularly mucormycetes. Mucormycosis can affect the sinuses, orbit, lungs, skin, or gastrointestinal tract, especially in people with diabetes or impaired

immunity.

**Synonyms:**

mucormycosis; phycomycosis

**Zygote**

The diploid cell formed when a sperm fertilizes an oocyte. It undergoes early cell divisions and develops into an embryo.

**Synonyms:**

fertilized egg

**Zymogen**

An inactive enzyme precursor that is converted into an active enzyme, often by proteolytic cleavage. Examples include pepsinogen and trypsinogen.

**Synonyms:**

proenzyme





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